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MODERN MEDICAL POCKET DICTIONARY

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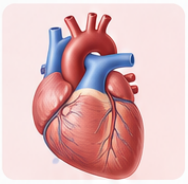
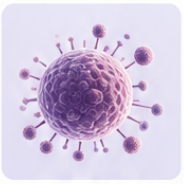
A COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE TO TODAY'S MEDICAL TERMS


ANATOMY

PHYSIOLOGY


DISEASES & CONDITIONS

SYMPTOMS & SIGNS

DIAGNOSIS & PROCEDURES

LABORATORY TESTS

IMAGING

BODY SYSTEMS

LIFE STAGES & SPECIALTIES

PUBLIC HEALTH & MORE

Knowledge for Better Health

A COMPACT REFERENCE
FOR STUDENTS, PROFESSIONALS
AND HEALTH-CONSCIOUS READERS

CHAMAN SINGH VERMA

Preface

This dictionary is a concise reference to medical terms, diseases, investigations, treatments, anatomy, physiology, and related clinical concepts. It is intended to help students, healthcare professionals, educators, and general readers understand unfamiliar medical language.

The entries are arranged alphabetically from A to Z, with each letter presented in its own chapter. This arrangement allows a reader to locate a known term quickly while maintaining a consistent structure throughout the book. Related terms, recognized common names, and alternative names are included when they improve clarity or aid searching.

Definitions are written in simple, formal language and are intended to be clear, accurate, and useful for reference. Medical terminology changes as scientific knowledge and clinical guidance develop; therefore, important information should be checked against current textbooks, primary research, professional guidance, and local clinical protocols.

This book is an educational reference, not a substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Readers should seek advice from a qualified healthcare professional when making decisions about health.

Chaman Singh Verma

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A

A1AT Deficiency

Abbreviation for alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency; see *Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency*.

A1C

Alternate name for the hemoglobin A1c test; see *Hemoglobin A1c*.

AA Amyloidosis

A systemic disease in which amyloid deposits form from serum amyloid A protein, usually after prolonged inflammation or infection. Deposits most often affect the kidneys but may involve other organs.

Alternate Names:
Amyloid A Amyloidosis; Secondary Amyloidosis; Secondary Systemic Amyloidosis

Aagenaes Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder that causes reduced flow of bile from the liver beginning in infancy and long-lasting swelling from lymph-fluid buildup, usually in the legs. Liver problems may come and go with age, but some people develop vitamin deficiency, poor growth, or liver scarring.

Aarskog-Scott Syndrome

A rare inherited developmental disorder, often related to FGD1 variants, characterized by distinctive facial features, short stature, skeletal differences, and genital anomalies.

Alternate Names:
Aarskog Syndrome

Aarskog Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Aarskog-Scott Syndrome*.

Aase-Smith Syndrome I

A rare congenital syndrome characterized by hydrocephalus, often associated with Dandy-Walker malformation, cleft palate, and severe joint contractures. Other reported features include thin fingers with absent or reduced knuckle creases, ear abnormalities, clubfoot, and heart defects. Its cause is not established.

Aase-Smith Syndrome II

A rare inherited disorder that causes reduced production of red blood cells and thumbs with three bones instead of the usual two.

Aase Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Aase-Smith Syndrome II*.

AAT

Abbreviation for alpha-1 antitrypsin, a protein made mainly in the liver that helps protect lung tissue from enzyme-related damage. Blood testing can measure its amount and type.

AAT Deficiency

Abbreviation for alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency; see *Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency*.

Abadie Sign

Reduced pain sensation when firm pressure is applied to the Achilles tendon, classically described in tabes dorsalis.

Abandoned Lead

A wire from a pacemaker or defibrillator that is no longer connected to the device but remains in the body. It may be left in place when removal poses greater risk, because scar tissue can attach it to a vein or the heart. Retained leads can complicate later device procedures, blood-vessel access, or management of infection.

Alternate Names:
Abandoned Pacemaker Lead; Abandoned ICD Lead

Abasia

Inability to walk because of impaired coordination of walking, despite enough leg strength to move the legs in other positions. Causes may be neurologic or functional.

Abate

To become less intense or to reduce in severity, frequency, or amount; symptoms, inflammation, pain, or fever may abate.

Abatement

A reduction in the severity, intensity, frequency, or amount of a symptom, disease process, exposure, or other condition.

ABCDE Assessment

A systematic emergency assessment of airway, breathing, circulation, disability, and exposure. It prioritizes recognition of life-threatening abnormalities and repeated reassessment.

ABCDE Rule For Melanoma

A screening mnemonic for pigmented lesions: asymmetry, border irregularity, color variation, diameter greater than about 6 mm, and evolution. It does not diagnose melanoma.

Abdomen

The body region between the diaphragm and pelvis. It contains most digestive organs, the kidneys, spleen, pancreas, and major blood vessels and is described clinically by four quadrants or nine regions.

Abdominal

Relating to the abdomen, the body region between the chest and pelvis that contains organs of the digestive, urinary, and reproductive systems.

Abdominal Abscess

A localized collection of pus within the abdomen, usually caused by bacterial infection, inflammation, surgery, or organ perforation. It may cause fever and abdominal pain.

Abdominal Adhesion

Alternate index label; see *Abdominal Adhesions*.

Abdominal Adhesions

Bands of scar-like tissue that form inside the abdomen and make two or more organs stick to each other or to the abdominal wall. They most often develop after surgery but may also follow infection, inflammation, endometriosis, or radiation; some are present from birth. They often cause no symptoms, but may cause long-lasting abdominal pain, infertility when they affect pelvic reproductive organs, or a partial or complete intestinal blockage. A blockage may cause pain, bloating, constipation, vomiting, or inability to pass gas.

Abdominal Angina

Pain in the abdomen after eating, caused by reduced blood flow through the arteries supplying the intestines. It is usually due to hardening and narrowing of these arteries.

Abdominal Aorta

The portion of the aorta below the diaphragm that extends to its bifurcation into the common iliac arteries. It supplies the abdominal organs, pelvic organs, and lower limbs through its branches.

Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm

A balloon-like bulge or enlargement in the wall of the abdominal aorta (the main blood vessel carrying blood from the heart through the abdomen). It develops when the vessel wall weakens over time, typically defined as reaching a diameter of 3 centimeters or greater. While often causing no symptoms

initially, a severe or enlarging aneurysm can tear or rupture, causing sudden severe abdominal, back, or flank pain, dizziness, and life-threatening internal bleeding.

Alternate Names:
AAA; Abdominal Aneurysm

Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Repair

Treatment of an abdominal aortic aneurysm to prevent rupture or control a rupture. Repair may be performed by open surgery, which replaces the weakened aortic segment with a graft, or by endovascular repair (EVAR), which places a stent graft inside the aorta.

Alternate Names:
AAA Repair

Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Screening

Use of ultrasonography in people without symptoms to detect an abdominal aortic aneurysm. Screening eligibility depends on risk factors and applicable guidelines. If an aneurysm is found, subsequent imaging is surveillance, with intervals based largely on aneurysm size. See also: *Abdominal Aortic Ultrasound*.

Abdominal Aortic Ultrasound

An imaging test that uses sound waves to visualize the abdominal aorta and detect or measure an aneurysm. It may be used for screening, diagnostic evaluation, or surveillance and does not use ionizing radiation. See also: *Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Screening*.

Abdominal Aponeurosis

A broad, flat sheet of tough connective tissue that attaches abdominal muscles to nearby muscles, bones, or fascia and helps form and strengthen the abdominal wall. The aponeuroses of the external oblique, internal oblique, and transversus abdominis contribute to the abdominal sheath and midline linea alba.

Abdominal Binder

A wide wrap worn around the abdomen to support the abdominal wall and apply gentle compression, often after surgery or injury.

Abdominal Bloating

A feeling of fullness, pressure, or tightness in the abdomen. It may occur with or without visible enlargement and is commonly caused by intestinal gas, constipation, food intolerance, or functional gastrointestinal disorders.

Abdominal Bruit

An abnormal blowing or whooshing sound heard over the abdomen with a stethoscope, usually caused by turbulent blood flow through a narrowed or enlarged artery. It may occur with renal-artery stenosis or an abdominal aortic aneurysm. Further assessment depends on symptoms and vascular risk factors.

Abdominal Cavity

The cavity between the diaphragm and pelvis containing the stomach, liver, gallbladder, spleen, pancreas, kidneys, and intestines.

Abdominal Circumference

The distance around the abdomen. In pregnancy, fetal abdominal circumference is measured by ultrasound at a standardized level that includes the stomach, portal sinus, and spine; it is used with other measurements to estimate fetal size and assess growth.

Abdominal Colic

Cramping abdominal pain caused by contractions or obstruction of a hollow organ, such as the intestine, ureter, or bile duct. Pain often comes in waves and may be accompanied by nausea, vomiting, sweating, or altered bowel or urinary function. Severe or persistent pain can reflect obstruction or another acute disorder.

Abdominal Compartment Syndrome

A syndrome of sustained intra-abdominal pressure greater than 20 mm Hg associated with new organ dysfunction or failure. It can impair kidney, lung, cardiovascular, and intestinal function. Causes include abdominal injury or disease, bleeding, severe

inflammation, intestinal edema, and major fluid resuscitation.

Abdominal CT

Computed tomography of the abdomen used to evaluate selected causes of abdominal pain, trauma, bowel obstruction, inflammation, bleeding, and masses. The protocol and use of contrast depend on the suspected condition and the patient's clinical status.

Abdominal CT Scan

Alternate name; see *Abdominal CT*.

Abdominal Distension

Visible or measured enlargement of the abdomen, often with a feeling of fullness or tightness. Causes include gas, constipation, fluid, pregnancy, enlarged organs, bowel obstruction, or bleeding; severe pain, vomiting, fever, or inability to pass stool or gas may occur with obstruction or bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Abdominal Swelling; Swollen Abdomen; Abdominal Distention

Abdominal Distention

Alternate name; see *Abdominal Distension*.

Abdominal Epilepsy

A rare and debated term for focal seizures in which abdominal sensations or symptoms are prominent. Similar symptoms have many more common causes, so the diagnosis requires evidence that the episodes are epileptic.

Alternate Names:
Autonomic Epilepsy; Gastrointestinal Epilepsy

Abdominal Exploration

Surgical examination of the abdominal cavity to locate, and sometimes treat, a suspected cause of symptoms or an abnormal finding. It may be done through an abdominal incision or with a laparoscope.

Abdominal Fat

Adipose tissue stored beneath the skin or around abdominal organs; excess visceral fat is metabolically active and associated with insulin resistance, fatty liver, and cardiovascular risk.

Abdominal Fibromatosis

Alternate name for an abdominal desmoid tumor, a fibrous growth that can invade nearby tissues but does not spread to distant organs; see *Desmoid Tumor*.

Abdominal Fluid

Fluid in the peritoneal cavity, the space around the abdominal organs. A small amount normally lubricates the organs; excess fluid is called ascites.

Alternate Names:
Peritoneal Fluid

Abdominal Girth

The distance around the abdomen, measured at a specified level. It may be used to monitor abdominal distention, fetal growth, obesity, ascites, or changes in intra-abdominal volume.

Abdominal Guarding

Tensing of the abdominal wall during examination, either voluntarily to limit pain or involuntarily in response to irritation of the peritoneum. Involuntary guarding may occur with peritonitis or other acute abdominal disease.

Abdominal Hernia

Protrusion of an organ or tissue through a weakness or opening in the abdominal wall. Common types include incisional, umbilical, epigastric, and ventral hernias.

Abdominal Hysterectomy

Surgical removal of the uterus through an incision in the abdominal wall; the cervix, ovaries, and fallopian tubes may or may not also be removed.

Abdominal Mass

A lump or enlargement in the abdomen that can

be felt on examination or seen on imaging. It may arise from an enlarged organ, hernia, cyst, abscess, or benign or cancerous tumor; the term describes a finding, not a diagnosis.

Abdominal Migraine

A recurrent disorder seen mainly in children, causing moderate to severe midline, periumbilical, or diffuse abdominal pain. Attacks last 2–72 hours, may include pallor, loss of appetite, nausea, or vomiting, and are separated by symptom-free intervals. Headache is absent during the abdominal attacks.

Abdominal MRI Scan

A magnetic resonance imaging study that produces detailed images of the abdomen using magnetic fields and radiofrequency energy.

Abdominal Muscles

The muscles forming the front and sides of the abdominal wall. They support the trunk, help with posture and breathing, and increase intra-abdominal pressure during coughing, lifting, and defecation.

Alternate Names:
Abdominal Wall Muscles

Abdominal Muscle Strain

A stretch or tear in the muscle fibers of the abdominal wall, such as the rectus abdominis or obliques, usually caused by sudden twisting, heavy lifting, or intense athletic exertion. Symptoms include localized abdominal soreness, swelling, and pain aggravated by coughing or bending.

Alternate Names:
Pulled Abdominal Muscle; Abdominal Wall Strain

Abdominal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in an organ or tissue of the abdomen. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause pain, swelling, bleeding, changes in bowel function, or no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Abdominal Tumor

Abdominal Neoplasms

Alternate index label; see *Abdominal Neoplasm*.

Abdominal Pain

Pain or discomfort in the area between the chest and pelvis. It may arise from the abdominal wall or organs, or be referred from another body region. Sudden severe pain, involuntary rigidity, fainting, persistent vomiting, fever, or blood in stool can occur with serious abdominal disease; abdominal pain in pregnancy may occur with ectopic pregnancy.

Abdominal Palpation

Part of a physical examination in which a clinician feels the abdomen with the hands to assess tenderness, muscle guarding, masses, or enlarged organs. Findings can guide further evaluation but do not identify a cause on their own.

Alternate Names:
Palpation of the Abdomen

Abdominal Point Tenderness

Pain felt in one specific area when the abdomen is pressed. It may occur with appendicitis, gallbladder inflammation, or other local disease; it does not identify the cause by itself.

Alternate Names:
Focal Abdominal Tenderness; Point Pain in Abdomen

Abdominal Pregnancy

An ectopic pregnancy in which the gestation implants in the peritoneal cavity, outside the uterus, fallopian tubes, and ovaries. It is rare and may implant on the peritoneum or abdominal organs; placental attachment can cause severe hemorrhage. Ultrasound is used for diagnosis, with MRI sometimes helping to clarify the implantation site.

Abdominal Quadrant

One of four topographical divisions of the abdomen made by the midline and a transverse plane through the umbilicus. The right upper, left upper, right lower, and left lower quadrants provide a standard way to record the location of pain, tenderness, or a mass.

Abdominal Radiography

A regular X-ray of the abdomen. It may be taken while a person is lying down, standing, or lying on their side.

Abdominal Reflex

Contraction of the abdominal muscles after stimulation of the abdominal skin. An absent or asymmetric reflex may indicate neurologic disease, although it can be absent normally in some people.

Abdominal Regions

The nine named areas used to describe locations on the abdominal wall: the right and left hypochondriac, epigastric, right and left lumbar, umbilical, right and left iliac, and hypogastric regions.

Abdominal Respiration

Breathing in which movement of the diaphragm produces prominent movement of the abdominal wall, especially during relaxed breathing. The pattern may be assessed when evaluating respiratory effort, breathing mechanics, or neuromuscular weakness.

Alternate Names:
Diaphragmatic Breathing

Abdominal Retractor

A surgical instrument used to hold back the abdominal wall or organs to improve access and visibility during an operation.

Alternate Names:
Abdominal Wall Retractor

Abdominal Rigidity

Involuntary tensing of the abdominal wall, usually caused by irritation of the peritoneum. It may occur with peritonitis, perforation, severe infection, or intra-abdominal bleeding.

Abdominal Sounds

Sounds produced by movement of gas and fluid through the intestines; changes in frequency or character may support, but do not establish, a diagnosis.

Abdominal Swelling

Alternate name; see *Abdominal Distension*.

Abdominal Tap

Alternate name; see *Abdominocentesis*.

Abdominal Thrusts

A first-aid maneuver used for severe choking in a responsive person. Current American Heart Association guidance alternates five back blows with five abdominal thrusts for adults and children; for infants, it alternates five back blows with five chest thrusts.

Abdominal Trauma

An injury to the abdomen caused by a blow, crash, or fall, or by an object that pierces the body. It may damage the abdominal wall, organs, or blood vessels and cause internal bleeding. Abdominal trauma is described as blunt or penetrating, depending on how the injury occurred.

Abdominal Ultrasound

An ultrasound examination that uses sound waves to produce images of the abdomen and assess its structure and blood flow when applicable.

Abdominal Wall

The layered muscular, fascial, and skin-covered boundary surrounding the abdominal cavity. It supports and protects abdominal organs and helps with posture, breathing, coughing, and straining. Weakness or defects may produce abdominal or incisional hernias; trauma, infection, and tumors may also affect the wall.

Abdominal Wall Fat Pad Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of abdominal fat to look for amyloid, usually with a special Congo-red stain. It is less invasive than biopsy of an affected organ, but a negative result does not rule out amyloidosis.

Abdominal Wall Hernia

Alternate name; see *Abdominal Hernia*.

Abdominal Wall Surgery

Surgery to repair a defect or disease of the abdominal wall, often a hernia. It may be open or laparoscopic, and mesh may or may not be used depending on the defect, location, and patient factors.

Abdominal X-Ray

Alternate name; see *Abdominal Radiography*.

Abdominocentesis

Inserting a needle through the abdominal wall into the space around the abdominal organs to remove or test extra fluid, called ascites.

Alternate Names:
Paracentesis

Abdominopelvic Cavity

The connected body space below the diaphragm containing abdominal and pelvic organs, including digestive, urinary, and reproductive structures, protected by surrounding muscles, bones, and lining tissues.

Abdominoperineal Resection

An operation that removes the anus, rectum, and usually part of the sigmoid colon. Because the normal anal outlet is removed, the surgeon creates a permanent colostomy, bringing the colon through the abdominal wall to drain stool into a bag. It may be used for selected low rectal or anal cancers.

Alternate Names:
APR

Abdominoplasty

A surgical procedure that removes excess abdominal skin and may tighten the abdominal wall.

Alternate Names:
Tummy Tuck

Abducens Nerve

The sixth cranial nerve. It controls the muscle that moves the eye outward. Damage to this nerve can prevent outward eye movement and cause double vision.

Abducens Nerve Diseases

Disorders affecting the sixth cranial nerve, which moves the eye outward. Injury or disease can weaken this movement and cause horizontal double vision; causes include diabetes-related nerve injury, raised pressure inside the skull, infection, inflammation, stroke, or trauma.

Abducens Nerve Palsy

Dysfunction of the sixth cranial nerve resulting in paralysis or paresis of the lateral rectus muscle. Clinically characterized by horizontal diplopia that worsens on gaze toward the affected side and convergent strabismus (esotropia) in primary gaze. Common etiologies include microvascular ischemia (diabetes mellitus, hypertension), elevated intracranial pressure (false localizing sign), trauma, and cavernous sinus lesions.

Alternate Names:
Sixth Nerve Palsy; CN VI Palsy

Abducent

Describing a muscle that moves a body part away from the midline. The term also appears in the older name “abducent nerve” for the abducens nerve (cranial nerve VI).

Abducent Nerve

Older alternate name; see *Abducens Nerve*.

Abduct

To move an arm, leg, finger, or other body part away from the center line of the body.

Abduction

Movement of a limb or other body part away from the median plane of the body. In ocular motility, it is movement of an eye outward, away from the nose.

Abductor Muscle

A muscle that moves a body part away from the midline or, for a digit, away from the axis of the hand or foot.

Abercrombie Syndrome

An older name for systemic amyloidosis, in which abnormal amyloid proteins accumulate in organs and impair their function.

Aberrant Conduction

Transient abnormal intraventricular conduction of a supraventricular electrical impulse through the ventricular conduction system, typically occurring when an impulse reaches bundle branch tissue during its relative refractory period. Most commonly presents as a wide QRS complex with right bundle branch block morphology following a sudden change in cycle length (Ashman phenomenon).

Alternate Names:
Aberrancy; Ventricular Aberration

Aberrant Right Subclavian Artery

A congenital vascular anomaly in which the right subclavian artery arises from the aortic arch distal to the left subclavian artery rather than from the brachiocephalic trunk. It travels behind the esophagus to reach the right arm and may occasionally compress the esophagus or trachea.

Alternate Names:
Arteria Lusoria

Aberration

A deviation from normal structure, function, or appearance; in optics, it is an imperfection that prevents light from forming a sharply focused image.

Abetalipoproteinemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot make normal particles that carry fat and cholesterol in the blood. It causes poor absorption of dietary fat, deficiencies of vitamins carried with fat, abnormal red blood cells, and possible nerve or eye disease.

Abfraction

A proposed explanation for some noncarious loss of tooth tissue near the gum line, in which repeated biting forces are thought to contribute. This mechanism remains debated and has not been established as the sole cause. Such defects are more neutrally called noncarious cervical lesions, which may involve acid exposure, toothbrushing abrasion, and mechanical stress.

Abiotrophy

Progressive loss of function in a tissue or organ as its cells degenerate. The term describes this process but does not specify which tissue is affected or what causes the degeneration.

Ablate

To remove or destroy tissue using surgery, heat, cold, chemicals, or another energy source. Ablation may treat abnormal heart rhythms, tumors, pain pathways, or other selected conditions.

Ablation

A procedure that removes or destroys tissue or stops an unwanted body function using surgery, heat, cold, electricity, medicines, or other methods.

Ablative Surgery

Surgery that destroys or removes abnormal tissue, often using excision, heat, cold, electrical energy, or other tissue-destructive methods.

Ablepharon

A rare congenital condition in which one or both eyelids are absent or severely underdeveloped. It can leave the eye exposed and may require protective treatment and reconstructive surgery.

Abnormal

Outside the expected range or appearance for a particular body structure, function, or test. An abnormal result may reflect disease, a temporary change, or normal variation; the term alone does not identify its cause or clinical importance.

Abnormal Color

A change in the usual color of the skin, the lining of the mouth or eyes, or a body fluid. Examples include pallor, bluish discoloration (cyanosis), yellowing (jaundice), and redness (erythema). These findings can reflect changes in blood flow, oxygenation, bilirubin, or inflammation; their meaning dif-

fers by site.

Alternate Names:
Discoloration

Abnormal (Dysfunctional) Uterine Bleeding

Dysfunctional uterine bleeding is a deprecated term formerly used for abnormal uterine bleeding without an identified structural cause. Current terminology describes the bleeding as abnormal uterine bleeding and classifies possible causes using FIGO PALM-COEIN. See *Abnormal Uterine Bleeding*.

Abnormal Fissure

An unusual crack or cleft in tissue, either because it occurs where no fissure is normally present or because it is unusually deep or wide. It may result from a developmental difference, injury, or inflammation; the finding alone does not identify its cause.

Abnormal Hemoglobins Testing

Blood testing that looks for unusual forms of hemoglobin, the oxygen-carrying protein in red blood cells. It helps diagnose inherited disorders such as sickle-cell disease and thalassemia; results may require specialized laboratory analysis.

Abnormality

A finding that differs from the expected structure, function, development, or test result. It may be harmless, temporary, or caused by disease; the word alone does not identify its cause or seriousness.

Abnormal Labor

Labor that is unusually slow, prolonged, arrested, or associated with abnormal contractions, fetal position, or signs that the fetus is not tolerating labor. The term includes several patterns of abnormal labor progress and is not a single diagnosis.

Abnormal Liver Function Tests

Abnormal blood-test results suggesting injury, inflammation, impaired bile flow, or reduced synthetic function of the liver. Commonly measured analytes include aminotransferases, alkaline phosphatase, bilirubin, albumin, and prothrombin time; patterns are interpreted with symptoms, medications, imaging, and other tests.

Abnormally Dark Or Light Skin

Skin that has become darker or lighter than a person's usual skin tone. Darkening is called hyperpigmentation and lightening is called hypopigmentation. Causes include inflammation or injury, sun exposure, medicines, infections, hormonal disorders, and genetic conditions.

Abnormally Excessive Sweating

See *Hyperhidrosis*.

Abnormal Pap Test

A cervical screening result showing abnormal cells or evidence of human papillomavirus. It does not by itself mean cancer; the findings range from minor cellular changes to abnormalities associated with a higher risk of cervical precancer.

Abnormal Posturing

An abnormal, sustained position of the body or limbs caused by severe dysfunction of the brain, brainstem, spinal cord, or muscles. Decorticate, decerebrate, and opisthotonic postures can occur with life-threatening neurologic injury.

Abnormal Reflex

A reflex response that is absent, reduced, unusually brisk, or unequal between sides on examination. It can point to dysfunction in the sensory or motor nerves, spinal cord, brain, or muscles; its meaning depends on which reflex is tested and the other examination findings.

Abnormal Tooth Shape

Abnormal tooth shape may result from developmental defects, genetic conditions, trauma, wear, or tumors and can affect function, appearance, and eruption.

Abnormal Uterine Bleeding

Bleeding from the uterus that differs from the usual pattern in amount, duration, frequency, or regularity

in a person who is not pregnant. Causes include changes in ovulation or hormones, fibroids, polyps, medicines, infection, and cancer. Bleeding after sex may come from the cervix or vagina rather than the uterus; bleeding during pregnancy is assessed separately.

Abnormal Uterine Bleeding (AUB)

Alternate name; see *Abnormal Uterine Bleeding*.

Abnormal Vaginal Bleeding

Alternate symptom label; see *Abnormal Uterine Bleeding*.

Abnormal Virilization

Development of masculinizing physical features in a person whose expected sex development does not include them, often from excess androgens.

Alternate Names:
Virilization

ABO Blood Group System

The major blood-group system defined by A and B antigens on red blood cells and usually by naturally occurring anti-A or anti-B antibodies in plasma. The four principal groups are A, B, AB, and O. Correct ABO matching is essential because incompatible transfusion can cause rapid, severe red-cell destruction.

Alternate Names:
ABO Blood Group ABO Blood Groups ABO Blood Types ABO System

ABO Blood Typing

Alternate name; see *ABO/Rh Typing*.

ABO Incompatibility

A mismatch between ABO blood groups that can cause red-cell destruction. In transfusion, recipient antibodies may trigger an acute hemolytic reaction; maternal IgG antibodies can cross the placenta and cause hemolysis and jaundice in a newborn, usually less severely than Rh-mediated disease.

ABO/Rh Typing

A laboratory test that determines a person's ABO and Rh blood groups. It is performed before transfusion, transplantation, and some obstetric procedures.

Abortion

The ending of a pregnancy, either spontaneously or by induction. An induced abortion is initiated with medicines or a medical procedure; spontaneous abortion, commonly called miscarriage, occurs without intentional intervention. The terms distinguish pregnancy loss from intentional termination.

Abortion Complications

Possible physical complications of pregnancy loss or induced abortion include heavy bleeding, retained pregnancy tissue, and infection; risks vary with the method, gestational age, and access to appropriate care. Emotional responses also vary and are not themselves a medical complication.

Abortive

Incomplete, unsuccessful, or stopped before full development; an abortive infection produces limited disease without the usual complete clinical course.

Abortive Polio

A mild, nonparalytic poliovirus infection causing nonspecific fever, sore throat, headache, nausea, or malaise without the neurologic findings of paralytic polio.

Above The Knee Amputation

Amputation of the lower limb through the thigh above the knee joint, usually performed for severe vascular disease, infection, trauma, or cancer.

Abrade

To wear away tissue by friction or erosion; an abrasion is the resulting scrape or superficial loss of skin.

Abrasion

A superficial injury in which the skin is scraped

or rubbed away, usually by friction. In dentistry, abrasion means mechanical wearing away of tooth structure by an external force.

Abrin

A highly toxic protein found in rosary pea seeds that blocks protein synthesis and kills cells. Poisoning after ingestion or inhalation can cause severe gastrointestinal illness, breathing problems, organ failure, and death.

ABR Test

Auditory brainstem response testing records electrical activity from the auditory nerve and brainstem through scalp electrodes to assess hearing and auditory-pathway function, especially in infants or people unable to provide reliable behavioral responses.

Abruptio Placenta

Alternate name; see *Abruptio Placentae*.

Abruptio Placentae

Premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall before delivery. It can cause vaginal bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fetal distress, and maternal shock.

Abs

An informal name for the muscles at the front and sides of the abdomen. They help bend and rotate the trunk, support the spine, protect abdominal organs, and increase pressure for coughing, lifting, breathing, or bowel movements.

Abscess

A localized collection of pus within tissue or an organ, usually caused by infection and surrounded by inflamed tissue. It may cause pain, swelling, warmth, or fever, although symptoms vary with its size and location. Abscesses can occur in skin, deeper tissues, organs, or body spaces.

Abscessed Tooth

A collection of pus caused by bacterial infection of the tooth or surrounding tissues, usually arising from untreated dental decay, a cracked tooth, or periodontal disease. Pain, facial swelling, fever, and sensitivity may occur. Spread into deep facial spaces can obstruct the airway or cause systemic infection.

Abscission

Separation or removal of tissue. In surgical use, it means cutting away tissue; in biology, it can mean the natural shedding of a body part, such as a leaf.

Absence Epilepsy

A generalized epilepsy with brief seizures that cause a sudden pause in activity and impaired awareness, often with staring or small repetitive movements. Awareness usually returns quickly without confusion; the seizures may occur many times a day.

Alternate Names:
Pyknolepsy; Petit Mal Epilepsy (historical term)

Absence Of Sweating

Anhidrosis is diminished or absent sweating, which may be focal or generalized. It impairs thermoregulation and can result from autonomic dysfunction, peripheral neuropathy, skin disease, medications, or congenital conditions. Severe generalized anhidrosis can cause heat intolerance and exertional hyperthermia.

Absence Of The Breast

Congenital absence of breast development, called amastia; it may affect one or both sides and can occur with other developmental anomalies.

Absence Seizure

A brief seizure causing sudden staring and reduced awareness, usually lasting only seconds with rapid recovery. The person may stop speaking or responding and may make small repetitive movements; an EEG helps confirm the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Petit Mal Seizure (historical term)

Absent Breath Sounds

Lack of audible air movement over part or all of

a lung. Causes include pneumothorax, pleural effusion, or airway obstruction; sudden onset may indicate an acute airway or lung disorder.

Absent Eye

Anophthalmia, a congenital absence or severe underdevelopment of the eye globe and ocular tissue; it may affect one or both eyes and may occur with other birth defects.

Absent Menstrual Periods

Alternate index label; see *Amenorrhea*.

Absent Pulmonary Valve

A birth defect in which the valve between the heart and the lung arteries is missing or severely underdeveloped. It can enlarge those arteries and cause breathing problems, poor blood flow to the lungs, or other heart defects.

Absent Reflex

Failure of an expected automatic movement to occur when a tendon or other body area is stimulated. It may suggest a problem in a nerve, nerve root, spinal cord, or muscle, although reflexes can normally differ between people and sides.

Absent Thirst

Reduced or absent desire to drink despite a potential need for fluids, which can occur with hypothalamic disease, aging, altered consciousness, medications, or severe illness.

Absolute Eosinophil Count

A laboratory blood test measuring the exact number of eosinophils per microliter of blood to evaluate allergic disorders, asthma, parasitic infections, drug reactions, or hypereosinophilic syndromes.

Alternate Names:
AEC; Absolute Eosinophils; Blood Eosinophil Count

Absolute Neutrophil Count

The actual number of circulating neutrophils (including both mature segmented neutrophils and immature bands) per microliter of blood, calculated as WBC$\times$(%segmented neutrophils+%bands)/100. A normal ANC is typically 1,500 to 8,000/μL. Neutropenia is defined as an ANC $< 1,500/\mu$L, with severe neutropenia defined as an ANC $< 500/\mu$L, which confers a markedly increased risk of invasive and life-threatening infections.

Alternate Names:
ANC

Absorb

To take in a substance, such as through the skin or intestine, or to reduce the intensity of radiation or light by taking up its energy.

Absorption

The passage of a substance across a body surface into body fluids or the bloodstream. In pharmacology, it is the movement of a drug from its administration site into systemic circulation. Intravenous administration places a drug directly in the bloodstream and therefore bypasses this process.

Abstinence

Deliberate avoidance of a substance or behavior, such as alcohol, tobacco, or sexual activity. In a person with physical dependence, stopping a substance may cause withdrawal. Withdrawal after prolonged heavy alcohol or sedative use can be medically dangerous; abstinence does not itself imply dependence or withdrawal.

Abulia

Marked reduction in motivation, initiative, and spontaneous activity, usually caused by dysfunction of frontal-subcortical brain circuits or related neurologic disease.

Abusive Head Trauma

Injury to an infant or young child caused by inflicted blunt impact, violent shaking, or both. Findings may include subdural hemorrhage, retinal hemorrhage, encephalopathy, fractures, or other injuries; diagnosis requires careful multidisciplinary assessment because no single finding is diagnostic.

Alternate Names:
Shaken Baby Syndrome (older term)

Abutment

A natural tooth, dental implant, or component that supports a dental prosthesis. Abutments may hold a bridge, denture, or implant crown in position and transfer chewing forces to the supporting tooth, implant, or bone.

Acalculia

Loss of the ability to do or understand numbers and calculations that a person could previously manage. It may result from injury or disease affecting areas of the brain involved in calculation.

Acalculous Cholecystitis

Inflammation of the gallbladder without gallstones. It usually occurs suddenly in people who are critically ill, injured, recovering from surgery, unable to eat, or in shock. Reduced bile flow and poor blood supply can contribute, and severe cases may cause tissue death or a hole in the gallbladder. Fever and pain in the upper-right abdomen may occur; ultrasound is commonly used for evaluation.

Acalculous Cholecystopathy

A term sometimes used for functional gallbladder disorder, which causes biliary-type pain without gallstones or another structural cause. Gallbladder dysmotility and a low ejection fraction on cholescintigraphy may support the diagnosis; terminology and diagnostic criteria vary.

Alternate Names:
Biliary Dyskinesia; Chronic Acalculous Gallbladder Disease

Acanthamoeba

A free-living amoeba found in soil and water that can cause corneal infection, skin or sinus infection, or rarely granulomatous amoebic encephalitis. Contact-lens exposure to contaminated water increases keratitis risk, while invasive disease is more likely with impaired immunity.

Acanthamoeba Keratitis

A rare corneal infection caused by the free-living amoeba *Acanthamoeba*. It is associated with contact lenses exposed to contaminated water and may cause severe eye pain, redness, light sensitivity, blurred vision, and a ring-shaped corneal infiltrate. The infection can damage the cornea and threaten sight.

Acanthocyte

An abnormal red blood cell with irregular, thorny or spike-like projections of varying length and width on its outer membrane. They are seen on a blood smear in advanced liver disease (such as cirrhosis), lipid metabolism disorders, abetalipoproteinemia, or neuroacanthocytosis.

Acanthocytosis

The presence of acanthocytes—red blood cells with irregular, thorn-like projections—in a blood sample. It can occur in inherited lipid disorders, advanced liver disease, and some neurological disorders; the cause depends on the clinical context.

Acantholysis

Loss of adhesion between keratinocytes, the main cells of the epidermis (outer skin layer). The cells separate, sometimes forming blisters or surface erosions. Acantholysis is a microscopic finding seen in disorders such as pemphigus and some inherited or infectious skin diseases; it is not a disease by itself.

Acanthoma

A nonspecific term for a proliferation or thickening of epidermal keratinocytes. It appears in the names of several distinct lesions; many are benign, but behavior depends on the specific subtype, and the term alone does not identify one diagnosis.

Acanthosis Nigricans

Dark, thickened, velvety skin, usually in folds such as the neck, armpits, or groin. It is often associated with insulin resistance, obesity, type 2 diabetes, hormonal disorders, or medicines; rarely, sudden extensive disease can signal an underlying cancer.

Acapnia

A marked deficiency or absence of carbon dioxide in the blood. The more commonly used term for a low arterial carbon-dioxide level is hypocapnia, often caused by breathing too quickly or deeply.

Acardia

A severe fetal anomaly in a monochorionic twin pregnancy in which one twin lacks a functional heart and depends on blood flow supplied by the co-twin through placental vascular connections. It occurs in twin reversed arterial perfusion sequence.

Acariasis

Illness or skin infestation caused by mites or ticks. It may cause itching, a rash, burrows, skin nodules, or deeper tissue inflammation; some mites and ticks can also transmit infection.

Acaricide

A pesticide used to kill mites and related arachnids such as ticks. It may be used on animals, plants, or environments; exposure can irritate skin and may cause poisoning if misused.

Acatalasemia

A rare inherited condition in which catalase, an enzyme that breaks down hydrogen peroxide, is absent or greatly reduced. Many people have no symptoms, but some develop mouth ulcers, tissue damage, or increased sensitivity to oxidative stress.

Alternate Names:
Acatalasia; Catalase Deficiency

Acatalasia

Alternate name; see *Acatalasemia*.

ACC

Abbreviation that may refer to: (1) adenoid cystic carcinoma (see *Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma*); (2) agenesis of the corpus callosum (see *Agenesis Of The Corpus Callosum*); or (3) aplasia cutis congenita (see *Aplasia Cutis Congenita*).

Accelerated Growth

An increase in a child's growth velocity above the expected rate for age and developmental stage, determined from serial height or length measurements. It may occur during normal puberty or catch-up growth; abnormal acceleration, especially with early pubertal signs or advanced bone age, may suggest precocious puberty or another endocrine disorder.

Accelerated Idioventricular Rhythm

A rhythm of wide electrical beats arising in the heart's lower chambers, often seen as blood flow returns after a heart attack. It is usually self-limited, but symptoms, the underlying cause, and other heart problems affect its significance.

Alternate Names:
AIVR

Accelerated-Phase Chronic Myeloid Leukemia

A term used in some classification systems for chronic myeloid leukemia showing features of progression. Criteria vary; the International Consensus Classification includes 10% to 19% blasts, while the 2022 World Health Organization classification no longer recognizes a separate accelerated phase.

Accelerometry

Measurement of movement or acceleration using a sensor. It can assess physical activity, walking, tremor, falls, sleep, or rehabilitation progress, depending on the device and the recording method.

Acceptable Daily Intake

The estimated amount of a substance that a person can consume every day throughout life without a meaningful health risk, based on available evidence and safety margins. It is usually expressed per kilogram of body weight.

Alternate Names:
ADI

Acceptance-Based Therapies

Psychotherapeutic approaches that help a person notice and accept thoughts, feelings, or bodily sensations while reducing unhelpful attempts to control or avoid them.

Alternate Names:
Acceptance-Based Psychotherapy; Acceptance-Focused Therapy

Access Needle

A hollow needle used to enter a blood vessel, body cavity, organ, or fluid collection. It may be used to take a sample, drain fluid, give treatment, or help place a catheter.

Alternate Names:
Introducer Needle; Percutaneous Access Needle; Vascular Access Needle

Accessory

Additional or supplementary; in anatomy, an accessory structure is an extra part or a structure that assists the usual organ or system.

Accessory Digestive Organ

An organ that supports digestion but is not part of the alimentary canal, such as the liver, pancreas, gallbladder, or salivary glands.

Accessory Muscles

Muscles recruited to assist the primary muscles of respiration or another movement when the normal workload is increased; use of respiratory accessory muscles may indicate respiratory distress.

Accessory Nerve

The eleventh cranial nerve (CN XI), a primarily motor nerve whose spinal component supplies the sternocleidomastoid and trapezius muscles. It enables head rotation and shoulder elevation; injury may cause weak head rotation, impaired shoulder shrug, and shoulder droop.

Alternate Names:
Cranial Nerve XI; Spinal Accessory Nerve

Accessory Pathway

An abnormal electrical connection between the atria and ventricles that can bypass the atrioventricular node and cause pre-excitation or tachyarrhythmias, including atrioventricular reentrant tachycardia.

Accessory Placenta

An extra placental lobe separate from the main placenta but connected to it by fetal blood vessels; it can increase the risk of retained placental tissue or vessel injury during delivery.

Accessory Spleen

A congenital nodule of normal splenic tissue separate from the main spleen, usually near the splenic hilum or tail of the pancreas. It is often found incidentally and should be distinguished from splenosis, which develops when splenic tissue implants elsewhere after injury or surgery.

Alternate Names:
Accessory Spleens; Splenule; Splenunculus; Supernumerary Spleen

Accidental Death

Death caused by an unintentional injury or event rather than disease, suicide, or homicide. The cause is determined through medical, scene, and sometimes legal investigation.

Alternate Names:
Unintentional Death

Accidental Fall

An unintentional movement to the ground or a lower level. Falls can cause bruises, fractures, head injury, or internal bleeding, especially in older adults; loss of consciousness, severe pain, or confusion may indicate serious injury.

Alternate Names:
Fall Injury

Accident And Emergency Medicine

Accident and emergency medicine is the specialty concerned with immediate evaluation and treatment of acute illness, injury, poisoning, and life-threatening emergencies.

Acclimation

Physiological adjustment to a changed environmental condition, such as temperature, oxygen availability, or altitude. Some technical usage distinguishes acclimation, which occurs under controlled or simulated conditions, from acclimatization in natural conditions. The terms are also used interchangeably, including in descriptions of high-altitude adaptation.

Accommodation

The ability of the eye to change the shape of its lens so that near objects can be focused clearly.

Accommodation Reflex

The coordinated adjustment of the lens, ciliary muscle, and pupils that shifts the eye from distance to near focus; it includes lens thickening, convergence, and pupillary constriction.

Accommodative Insufficiency

Inability of the eye to increase lens power adequately for near focusing, causing eyestrain, blurred near vision, headache, or difficulty reading.

Accouchement

Accouchement is the process of childbirth, including labor, delivery of the infant, and expulsion of the placenta.

Accretion

Gradual buildup or growth of material that makes an object or body tissue larger. Examples include crystals forming in fluid, extra bone developing after injury, or plaque collecting on teeth.

ACE Blood Test

A blood test measuring angiotensin-converting enzyme. It may support evaluation of sarcoidosis and some other inflammatory or liver disorders, but an abnormal result is not specific and cannot diagnose a disease by itself.

Acebutolol

Acebutolol is a beta-adrenergic blocker with intrinsic sympathomimetic activity used in some settings for hypertension and cardiac rhythm disorders; it can slow heart rate and conduction.

ACE Inhibitors

Medicines that reduce formation of angiotensin II, lowering blood pressure and pressure within the kidney's filtering units. They are used for hypertension, heart failure, and selected kidney or cardiovascular conditions. Risks include cough, high potassium, kidney-function changes, and rare facial or airway swelling; exposure during pregnancy can injure fetal kidneys.

Acellular

Without cells. An acellular material may consist of fluid, minerals, or the supporting material around cells and may be natural, diseased, or used in a medical product.

Acentric Chromosome

A chromosome fragment that lacks a centromere and therefore usually cannot attach normally to the spindle during cell division.

Acephalostomia

An extremely rare and severe birth defect involving absence or major failure of development of the head and mouth. It is usually incompatible with survival and is identified during prenatal or newborn examination.

Acetabular Fractures

Breaks or cracks in the acetabulum, the curved cup-like socket of the pelvis that forms the hip joint with the head of the femur. They often follow high-energy trauma but can occur after low-energy falls in older adults with fragile bones, causing groin pain and difficulty bearing weight.

Alternate Names:
Acetabulum Fracture; Pelvic Socket Fracture

Acetabular Fracture

Alternate name; see *Acetabular Fractures*.

Acetabular Labrum

A fibrocartilaginous rim attached to the margin of the acetabulum that deepens the hip socket, helps maintain a fluid seal, and contributes to hip-joint stability.

Acetabular Notch

The indentation in the inferior margin of the acetabulum, bridged by the transverse ligament of the acetabulum and forming a passage for structures

entering the hip joint.

Acetabuloplasty

A surgical procedure that reshapes or augments the acetabular rim or socket to improve coverage of the femoral head in selected structural hip disorders.

Acetabulum

The cup-shaped socket of the hip formed by the fused ilium, ischium, and pubis. It articulates with the femoral head and is deepened by the acetabular labrum.

Acetaldehyde

A chemical produced when the body metabolizes alcohol. Accumulation may contribute to flushing, nausea, and vomiting.

Acetaminophen

A medicine that relieves pain and reduces fever but has little anti-inflammatory effect. Excessive doses, including combined use of multiple acetaminophen-containing products, can cause severe liver injury. Heavy alcohol use can increase the risk of liver damage.

Alternate Names:
Paracetamol; APAP

Acetaminophen And Codeine Overdose

A medical emergency caused by ingesting toxic amounts of a combination pain medicine. It produces dual life-threatening effects: codeine suppresses the central nervous system, causing extreme drowsiness, slowed or stopped breathing, and coma, while acetaminophen depletes protective liver antioxidants, leading to progressive liver failure.

Alternate Names:
Co-Codamol Overdose; Tylenol with Codeine Overdose

Acetaminophen Overdose

Taking more acetaminophen than the body can safely process, causing serious liver damage. Early symptoms may be mild or absent; nausea, abdominal pain, jaundice, and liver failure can develop later. N-acetylcysteine is an antidote and is most effective when started early, but may still help later.

Alternate Names:
Acetaminophen Toxicity; Acetaminophen Poisoning; Paracetamol Toxicity; Paracetamol Overdose; APAP Overdose

Acetaminophen Poisoning

Alternate name; see *Acetaminophen Overdose*.

Acetaminophen Toxicity

Alternate name; see *Acetaminophen Overdose*.

Acetate

A form of acetic acid and a small molecule used by cells in energy and building processes. The body can convert acetate into acetyl-CoA, which helps make or break down fats and other substances.

Acetazolamide

A medicine that changes salt and fluid handling in the kidneys. It is used for glaucoma, prevention or treatment of altitude illness, and selected fluid, metabolic, or neurologic conditions.

Acetone

A volatile ketone body produced during increased fat metabolism. It may contribute to the characteristic breath odor of ketosis and ketoacidosis.

Acetone Body

A ketone produced when the body breaks down fat for energy. Acetone is one of three main ketones and can contribute to the distinctive breath odor of prolonged fasting or diabetic ketoacidosis.

Acetone Breath

A distinctive sweet, fruity odor on the breath caused by the exhalation of volatile acetone, a ketone body produced during accelerated lipolysis and ketogenesis. It is a characteristic physical examination finding in diabetic ketoacidosis (DKA), as well as in severe starvation, prolonged fasting, and ketogenic metabolic states.

Alternate Names:

Fruity Breath; Ketotic Breath; Diabetic Breath Odor

Acetone Poisoning

Harm from swallowing or breathing a large amount of acetone, a solvent found in some products. It may cause irritation, dizziness, vomiting, drowsiness, low blood pressure, or breathing problems; severe exposure can be life-threatening.

Acetonuria

The presence of acetone or other ketone bodies in the urine, which may occur with fasting, vomiting, uncontrolled diabetes, or other states of increased fat metabolism.

Acetylation

A chemical change that adds a small acetyl group to a protein, medicine, or DNA-related molecule. This can alter how the molecule works, how long it lasts, how it is moved, or how strongly a gene is active.

Acetylcholine

A chemical messenger used by nerve cells in the brain and body. It carries signals between nerves at autonomic ganglia, from parasympathetic nerves to organs, and from motor nerves to skeletal muscles. In the brain, it plays roles in attention, learning, and memory. It is made from choline and acetyl-CoA.

Acetylcholine Receptor Antibody

Acetylcholine receptor antibody testing detects antibodies associated with autoimmune myasthenia gravis and is interpreted with the neurologic examination and other studies.

Acetylcholinesterase

An enzyme that quickly breaks down acetylcholine, a chemical messenger, into choline and acetate at nerve connections, including the junction between a nerve and a muscle. This helps stop the acetylcholine signal. Some medicines and toxic chemicals act by blocking this enzyme.

Alternate Names:
AChE; Acetylcholine Acetylhydrolase

Acetylcholinesterase Inhibitors

Medicines that slow the breakdown of acetylcholine, increasing its activity at nerve connections. They are used in conditions such as Alzheimer disease and myasthenia gravis; some agents also reverse nondepolarizing neuromuscular blockade after anesthesia.

Acetyl-CoA Carboxylase

An enzyme that begins the process of making fatty acids by changing acetyl-CoA into malonyl-CoA. Its activity responds to the cell's energy supply and to hormones, helping balance fat production with energy needs.

Acetyl-Coenzyme A

A substance used in many energy and building processes inside cells. It helps release energy from food and provides material for making fatty acids, cholesterol, and ketones.

Acetylcysteine

A medicine that loosens thick mucus so it is easier to clear. It is also the main antidote for acetaminophen overdose because it restores glutathione, a substance the liver uses to neutralize the overdose's toxic breakdown product.

Acetylsalicylic Acid

Alternate index label; see *Aspirin*.

ACH

Abbreviation commonly used for achondroplasia, a genetic skeletal disorder causing disproportionate short stature and characteristic changes in the skull, spine, and long bones.

ACh (Acetylcholine)

Alternate name; see *Acetylcholine*.

Achalasia

A disorder in which the muscle ring between the esophagus and stomach does not relax properly, and the esophagus cannot move food normally into the stomach. It causes difficulty swallowing and regurgitation.

Alternate Names:
Cardiospasm; Esophageal Achalasia

Achalasia Of The Cardia

A disorder in which the valve between the esophagus and stomach does not relax properly and the esophagus loses its normal squeezing movement. Food and liquid can collect in the esophagus, causing progressive difficulty swallowing, regurgitation, chest discomfort, and weight loss.

AChE (Acetylcholinesterase)

Alternate name; see *Acetylcholinesterase*.

Achenbach's Syndrome

A benign condition of recurrent, painful, spontaneous hematoma formation in the pulp of a finger or thumb, typically affecting middle-aged women. It presents with sudden onset of throbbing pain and blue-black discoloration of the fingertip, resolving spontaneously over one to two weeks without treatment.

Achenbach Syndrome

A benign, self-limiting disorder characterized by the sudden onset of acute pain, swelling, and bluish discoloration or hematoma on the palmar surface of one or more fingers, occurring without identifiable significant trauma.

Alternate Names:
Paroxysmal Finger Hematoma; Acute Blue Finger Syndrome

Achilles Paratenonitis

Inflammation of the paratenon, the loose protective sheath of tissue surrounding the Achilles tendon. It causes swelling, localized warmth, tenderness, and a characteristic crepitus or friction sensation during movement of the ankle.

Alternate Names:
Achilles Peritendinitis

Achilles Tendinitis

Painful irritation or degeneration of the tendon joining the calf muscles to the heel. It usually follows repeated loading and can cause stiffness, swelling, tenderness, and pain during walking or exercise.

Alternate Names:
Achilles Tendinopathy; Calcaneal Tendinitis

Achilles Tendinopathy

Pain and structural changes in the Achilles tendon, usually associated with repeated loading. It commonly causes pain and stiffness at the back of the heel, especially after rest or during walking, running, and jumping. The term describes a tendon disorder and does not necessarily imply active inflammation.

Achilles Tendon

The tendon connecting the calf muscles, gastrocnemius and soleus, to the calcaneus, or heel bone. It transmits muscle force to the foot and contributes to plantarflexion, the movement that points the foot downward. This action helps propel the body during walking, running, and jumping.

Alternate Names:
Calcaneal Tendon; Tendo Calcaneus; Achilles' Tendon

Achilles Tendonitis

A commonly used term for pain and inflammation or degeneration of the Achilles tendon. It may affect the tendon at its heel insertion or its mid-portion and is often related to repetitive loading.

Achilles Tendon Problems

Disorders affecting the Achilles tendon, including tendinitis, tendinopathy, bursitis, partial tear, and rupture. They can cause pain, stiffness, swelling, or sudden loss of push-off strength.

Achilles Tendon Repair

Surgery that reconnects a completely or severely torn Achilles tendon. The ankle is protected in a cast or brace afterward, followed by gradual exercises to restore movement and strength; recovery takes several months.

Achilles Tendon Rupture

A partial or complete tear of the Achilles tendon,

usually caused by sudden force. It causes posterior ankle pain, weakness in plantar flexion, and difficulty walking or standing on tiptoe.

Achillobursitis

Inflammation of a bursa near the Achilles tendon, causing pain, tenderness, swelling, or friction-related discomfort at the back of the heel.

Achlorhydria

A condition in which the stomach produces no hydrochloric acid; reduced but not absent acid is called hypochlorhydria. It can occur with autoimmune gastritis or loss of acid-producing stomach cells and may impair absorption of iron or vitamin B12. Acid-suppressing medicines usually reduce acid rather than cause complete achlorhydria.

Achondrogenesis

A group of severe inherited disorders in which cartilage and bone development is profoundly impaired. Affected fetuses have very short limbs and poorly formed bones, and most cases are fatal before or shortly after birth.

Achondroplasia

An autosomal dominant bone-growth disorder caused by a disease-causing change in the *FGFR3* gene. It causes short arms and legs, short stature, a larger head, and a prominent forehead. One altered gene copy usually causes the condition; two copies cause a severe, often fatal form.

Alternate Names:
Chondrodystrophy; Achondroplastic Dwarfism

Achoo Syndrome

The photic sneeze reflex: repeated sneezing triggered by sudden exposure to bright light, especially after entering sunlight from darkness.

Achromatopsia

Absent or severely reduced color vision. The term usually refers to an inherited retinal disorder, which also causes light sensitivity and reduced visual acuity; it can also refer to acquired loss of color perception after damage to color-processing areas of the brain (cerebral achromatopsia).

Alternate Names:
Complete Color Blindness

Achromia

Achromia is loss or marked reduction of pigment in skin, hair, eye, or another tissue; causes include genetic disorders, autoimmune depigmentation, injury, and chemical exposure.

Aciclovir

Alternate spelling; see *Acyclovir*.

Acid

A substance that donates hydrogen ions (protons) in solution or accepts an electron pair in a chemical reaction. In water, acids increase hydrogen-ion activity. Strong acids can damage tissue, while acids also participate in normal digestion, metabolism, and body-fluid regulation.

Acid-Base Analysis

Evaluation of blood pH, bicarbonate, and carbon dioxide to identify metabolic or respiratory disturbances, including those caused by poisoning.

Acid Base Balance

The body's control of acids and bases in its fluids, especially the blood. The lungs remove carbon dioxide and the kidneys adjust acids and bicarbonate to keep blood pH within a narrow safe range.

Acid-Base Disorder

A problem that makes the blood too acidic or too alkaline. It may result from changes in breathing, kidney function, metabolism, or severe illness. Blood tests help identify the cause and whether the body is compensating.

Acid-Base Imbalance

Alternate name; see *Acid-Base Disorder*.

Acidemia

An abnormally low arterial blood pH (below 7.35), indicating an increased hydrogen ion concentration

in circulating blood. It is the measurable laboratory state resulting from an underlying respiratory or metabolic acidosis.

Acid-Fast Bacilli

Bacteria that retain the primary stain after an acid-alcohol wash during acid-fast staining. Most are mycobacteria, including the bacteria that cause tuberculosis and leprosy; *Nocardia* and some related bacteria may be weakly acid-fast. A positive smear does not identify the species.

Alternate Names:
AFB; Acid-Fast Bacteria

Acid-Fast Bacillus Smear

Microscopic examination of a specimen, often sputum, for acid-fast organisms using a special stain. A positive result supports mycobacterial infection but does not by itself identify the species or establish drug susceptibility; culture or molecular testing is also required.

Acid-Fast Stain

A special dye test used to find mycobacteria and a few related organisms in samples such as sputum. A positive result does not identify the species or show which medicines will work.

Acid Indigestion

A nonspecific term for upper-abdominal discomfort, often with burning, fullness, belching, or nausea. It does not necessarily mean excess stomach acid and may occur with reflux, dyspepsia, gastritis, ulcer disease, or other conditions.

Acid Loading Test

A specialized test of how well the kidneys remove acid from the body. After a carefully controlled acid dose, urine is measured for acidity and other substances to investigate suspected kidney-tubule problems.

Acid Mucopolysaccharides

An older name for long sugar chains found in supporting tissues such as cartilage, skin, and joint fluid. Abnormal breakdown or storage of these substances causes a group of inherited storage disorders.

Acidophil

A cell or tissue part that absorbs acidic laboratory dyes strongly, especially the pink dye eosin. The pattern helps pathologists recognize certain cells in tissue samples, including some pituitary cells.

Acidophilus

Lactobacillus acidophilus, a lactic-acid-producing bacterium found in the intestinal and genital microbiota and used in some fermented foods and probiotic products.

Acidosis

An abnormal bodily state in which body fluids become overly acidic, lowering the blood's normal pH balance. It is divided into two main types: **respiratory acidosis**, which occurs when the lungs cannot breathe out enough carbon dioxide; and **metabolic acidosis**, which occurs when the kidneys cannot remove enough acid, when excess acids build up (such as from diabetes or severe infection), or when the body loses too much bicarbonate.

Acid Phosphatase

An enzyme that works best in acidic conditions and is found in several tissues, including prostate and blood cells.

Alternate Names:
ACP

Acid Reflux

Backward flow of acidic stomach contents into the esophagus, causing heartburn, sour regurgitation, cough, or throat irritation. Frequent reflux may be gastroesophageal reflux disease and can injure the esophagus.

Acid Soldering Flux Poisoning

Injury from swallowing or inhaling acidic chemicals used in soldering. It may burn the mouth, throat, skin, or eyes and can cause vomiting, breathing difficulty, or dangerous changes in body chemistry.

Acid Sphingomyelinase Deficiency

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient acid sphingomyelinase, usually because of disease-causing variants in the *SMPD1* gene. Sphingomyelin accumulates in cells and may cause enlarged liver or spleen, lung disease, bone changes, or neurologic impairment; the condition was historically classified as Niemann–Pick disease types A and B.

Aciduria

Aciduria means an abnormally acidic urine or the presence of excess organic acids in urine; it may reflect diet, dehydration, medication, or an inherited metabolic disorder.

Acinar Cell

A cell in a small cluster that makes and releases a fluid or substance. In the pancreas, acinar cells release digestive enzymes into small ducts.

Acinar Cell Carcinoma

A rare cancer of cells that resemble enzyme-secreting acinar cells, most often arising in the pancreas. It can form a mass and cause nonspecific abdominal symptoms.

Acinetobacter Baumannii Resistance

Resistance means that Acinetobacter baumannii is not killed by one or more antibiotics. It can cause difficult hospital infections, especially in intensive-care units, so culture and susceptibility testing guide treatment.

Acinus

A small working unit of a gland made of cells that release their product into a duct. Examples include the secretory units of the pancreas and salivary glands.

AC Joint

The acromioclavicular joint, a gliding joint between the acromion of the scapula and the clavicle at the top of the shoulder.

ACL Injury

A sprain or tear of the strong ligament inside the knee that helps prevent the shinbone from sliding too far forward. It commonly follows twisting or sudden stopping and may cause a pop, swelling, pain, or a feeling that the knee gives way.

ACL Reconstruction

Surgery that replaces a torn anterior cruciate ligament inside the knee with a tendon graft. It may restore stability after injury, especially when the knee gives way or the person plans activities requiring pivoting; rehabilitation is required afterward.

ACL Tear

Alternate name; see *Anterior Cruciate Ligament Tear*.

Acne

A common inflammatory disorder of the pilosebaceous units, which consist of hair follicles and their attached oil glands. Follicular blockage can form open comedones (blackheads) or closed comedones (whiteheads); inflammation may produce papules, pustules, or nodules and can lead to scarring or dark marks.

Alternate Names:
Acne Vulgaris; Pimples

Acne Conglobata

A rare, severe nodulocystic form of acne with groups of inflammatory nodules, cysts, interconnected abscesses, and draining sinuses, usually on the trunk, buttocks, or limbs. It can be persistent, recur, and leave atrophic or hypertrophic scars.

Acne Fulminans

A sudden, severe ulcerating form of acne associated with fever, painful joints, malaise, and sometimes weight loss or abnormal blood counts. It is a systemic inflammatory emergency, and isotretinoin exposure can precipitate or worsen the eruption.

Acneiform Eruptions

Monomorphic follicular papules and pustules that

resemble acne but usually lack comedones. They may be caused by medicines, occupational or chemical exposures, infections, or other disorders; timing, distribution, and trigger help distinguish them from acne vulgaris.

Acne Inversa

See *Hidradenitis Suppurativa*.

Acne Keloid

A chronic inflammatory condition causing firm scar-like bumps around hair follicles, usually on the back of the neck.

Alternate Names:
Acne Keloidalis Nuchae

Acne Keloidalis Nuchae (AKN)

Alternate name; see *Acne Keloid*.

Acne Papules

Small, solid, raised bumps caused by inflammation around hair follicles, often as part of acne. Unlike pustules, papules contain no visible pus.

Alternate Names:
Inflammatory Acne Bumps

Acne Rosacea

Alternate name; see *Rosacea*.

Acne Scars

Permanent textural changes and indentations or raised fibrous tissue that develop in the skin after severe or untreated inflammatory acne lesions heal with abnormal collagen formation.

Alternate Names:
Post-Acne Scarring; Cicatricial Acne

Acne Vulgaris

A common disorder of hair follicles involving follicular plugging, increased oil production, and inflammation in which Cutibacterium acnes may contribute. It causes blackheads or whiteheads and may also cause inflamed papules, pustules, or deep nodules on the face, chest, back, and upper arms; deeper disease can scar.

Acoustic

Relating to sound or hearing. In medicine, the term describes sound waves and hearing-related phenomena, including their production, transmission, and reception. It appears in terms for auditory tests, reflexes, and structures associated with hearing.

Acoustic Nerve

The acoustic nerve, properly called the vestibulocochlear nerve, carries signals for hearing and balance from the inner ear to the brain. It is the eighth cranial nerve.

Acoustic Neuroma

Alternate name; see *Vestibular Schwannoma*.

Alternate Names:
Vestibular Schwannoma; Acoustic Neurinoma; Acoustic Neurilemmoma

Acoustic Reflex

An automatic tightening of a small middle-ear muscle in response to a loud sound. Testing it helps assess the middle ear, hearing pathways, and facial nerve.

Alternate Names:
Stapedial Reflex; Stapedius Reflex; Middle-Ear Muscle Reflex

Acoustic Shock

Auditory and other symptoms after exposure to a sudden or intense sound, potentially including ear pain, tinnitus, hyperacusis, dizziness, or temporary hearing change.

Acoustic Trauma

Acute damage to the auditory system from a brief, intense sound such as an explosion or firearm. It may cause tinnitus, temporary or permanent sensorineural hearing loss, and tympanic or ossicular injury. Sudden hearing loss may occur.

Acquired

Developed after birth rather than being present at birth or inherited; an acquired condition may result from infection, exposure, injury, aging, or another

later event.

Acquired C1-Inhibitor Deficiency Angioedema

A bradykinin-mediated disorder caused by acquired deficiency or dysfunction of C1 inhibitor, often associated with lymphoproliferative or autoimmune disease. Recurrent swelling of the skin, bowel wall, or upper airway usually occurs without hives or itching; low C1q and C1-inhibitor testing help distinguish it from hereditary or histamine-mediated angioedema.

Acquired Cystic Kidney Disease

Development of multiple fluid-filled cysts in kidneys with long-standing chronic kidney disease, especially kidney failure. It may cause blood in the urine, pain, or infection and is associated with an increased risk of renal cell carcinoma. Many cysts cause no symptoms.

Acquired Feminization

Development of typically female secondary sexual characteristics after birth in a person not expected to develop them, often from hormonal change.

Acquired Heart Disease

Heart disease that develops after birth, commonly from coronary artery disease, hypertension, infection, inflammation, valve disease, or other acquired conditions.

Acquired Immunity

Specific immune protection gained after birth through the body's response to infection or vaccination (active immunity), or through transferred antibodies (passive immunity).

Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome

The advanced stage of disease caused by infection with the human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), characterized by profound destruction of CD4+ T helper lymphocytes (typically defined by a CD4+ T-cell count $< 200/\mu$L or a CD4+ percentage $< 14\%$) leading to severe opportunistic infections, secondary neoplasms (such as Kaposi sarcoma and non-Hodgkin lymphoma), and systemic wasting. See also: *AIDS*.

Alternate Names:
AIDS; Stage 3 HIV Infection

Acquired Lipodystrophy

A group of disorders in which body fat is lost after birth rather than because of an inherited condition. Fat loss may be widespread or limited to certain body regions. Causes include autoimmune disease, inflammation of fat tissue, infection, and some medicines; metabolic effects vary with the amount and pattern of fat loss.

Acquired Methemoglobinemia

A disorder in which an oxidizing medicine or chemical changes the iron in hemoglobin so it cannot carry oxygen normally. It may cause bluish skin, headache, or breathlessness. Causes include dapsone, benzocaine, and nitrites; diagnosis is confirmed by measuring methemoglobin in blood.

Alternate Names:
Toxic Methemoglobinemia; Drug-Induced Methemoglobinemia; Chemically Induced Methemoglobinemia

Acquired Nasolacrimal Duct Obstruction

Blockage of the tear-drainage system that develops after birth. It may cause excessive tearing, discharge, or repeated inflammation of the lacrimal sac and can result from aging, infection, injury, inflammation, scarring, or a mass.

Acquired Platelet Function Defect

Impaired platelet adhesion or aggregation that develops after birth. Causes include antiplatelet medicines, kidney failure, hematologic disease, and other systemic disorders; platelet counts may remain normal, but mucocutaneous bleeding can occur.

Acquired Tracheomalacia

Acquired tracheomalacia is weakening of the tracheal wall after injury, inflammation, compression, or prolonged ventilation, causing airway collapse and breathing symptoms.

Acquisition

The process by which new information or a skill is learned and initially encoded, especially in discussions of memory and learning.

Alternate Names:
Learning Acquisition; Memory Acquisition

Acquisition Duration

The time required to collect a measurement, image, or body signal. Longer acquisition may improve detail or accuracy but can increase motion problems, discomfort, radiation exposure, or equipment time.

Acquisition Time

The time during which a medical imaging system collects data. The required time depends on the imaging method, body region, protocol, and patient movement.

Acral Lentiginous Melanoma

A subtype of melanoma arising on acral skin (palms, soles, or under nails), appearing as a dark, irregularly pigmented patch or plaque. It is more common in people with darker skin tones and often presents at a later stage due to less frequent surveillance of these sites. Prognosis depends on thickness and stage at diagnosis.

Acroangiodermatitis

Alternate name; see *Pseudo-Kaposi Sarcoma (Acroangiodermatitis)*.

Acrocallosal Syndrome

A rare congenital developmental syndrome, usually inherited in an autosomal recessive pattern, characterized by partial or complete absence of the corpus callosum, distinctive craniofacial features, and extra digits. Developmental delay or intellectual disability is common, while brain, skeletal, and other abnormalities vary. Some cases are associated with biallelic variants in the *KIF7* gene.

Acrocentric Chromosome

A chromosome whose central joining point lies close to one end, giving it a very short section and a longer section. In humans, chromosomes 13, 14, 15, 21, and 22 have this shape.

Acrochordon

Alternate name; see *Skin Tag*.

Acrocyanosis

Persistent bluish or purplish discoloration and coolness of the hands, feet, nose, or ears, usually without pain, caused by narrowing of small skin blood vessels. It is often worse in cold conditions and may be primary or due to another disorder.

Acrodermatitis

Inflammation affecting skin on the hands, feet, or other body extremities. Causes vary and include infections, nutritional deficiency, inherited disorders, medicines, and immune reactions; appearance and treatment depend on cause.

Acrodermatitis Chronica Atrophicans

A late cutaneous manifestation of Lyme borreliosis, usually caused by persistent *Borrelia afzelii* infection in Europe. It begins with unilateral reddish-violet swelling on an extremity and can progress over months or years to thin, atrophic, fibrotic skin; diagnosis uses clinical findings, serology, and sometimes biopsy.

Acrodermatitis Enteropathica

A zinc-deficiency disorder classically causing periorificial and acral dermatitis, diarrhea, and alopecia. The primary inherited form results from impaired intestinal zinc absorption; acquired deficiency may follow malnutrition, malabsorption, or other illness, and untreated disease can impair growth, healing, and immunity.

Acrodynia

A painful condition with red, swollen, sweaty hands and feet, classically associated with mercury poisoning and historically called pink disease in children.

Acrodysostosis

A rare inherited disorder of bone development caus-

ing short, broad fingers and toes, a small nose and middle face, and short stature. Some people have learning difficulties or reduced response to parathyroid and other hormones.

Acrokeratosis Paraneoplastica

A rare skin condition causing thick, wart-like growths on the hands and feet, often around the nails, as a reaction to an internal cancer. It is most often linked with cancers of the digestive or respiratory tract.

Acromegaly

A rare hormonal disorder that occurs in adults when the pituitary gland at the base of the brain produces too much growth hormone, usually due to a non-cancerous tumor. Because the bones can no longer grow longer in adulthood, the excess hormone causes gradual enlargement of the bones and soft tissues of the hands, feet, face, and jaw, as well as joint pain, high blood pressure, and metabolic changes.

Alternate Names:
Pituitary Gigantism (pediatric counterpart before epiphyseal closure); Somatotropinoma

Acrometastasis

Metastatic spread of cancer to a distal part of a limb, especially the bones of the hands or feet and less often nearby soft tissues. Acrometastases are rare and often occur in advanced cancer; the lung is a common primary site.

Alternate Names:
Acrometastases

Acromioclavicular Joint

The small joint at the top of the shoulder where the collarbone meets the shoulder blade. It allows limited gliding as the arm moves and is held stable mainly by two groups of strong ligaments.

Acromioclavicular Joint Injuries

Sprains or dislocations of the joint between the acromion and clavicle, usually caused by a fall or direct shoulder impact. Severity ranges from ligament sprain to complete displacement and is assessed clinically and with imaging.

Alternate Names:
Acromioclavicular Joint Injury

Acromion

A bony projection from the shoulder blade that forms the highest point of the shoulder. It joins the collarbone and forms a roof over the shoulder joint, with a tendon and lubricating sac passing beneath it.

Acro-Osteolysis

Resorption or destruction of the terminal bones of the fingers or toes. It can occur with inherited disorders, autoimmune disease, severe vascular disease, trauma, or repeated occupational exposure and may cause shortened, painful, or deformed digits.

Acroparaesthesia

Acroparaesthesia is tingling, pins-and-needles, burning, or altered sensation in the hands or feet, commonly related to nerve compression, neuropathy, vascular disease, or metabolic causes.

Acrophobia

An excessive, persistent fear of heights that causes marked anxiety, avoidance, or impairment beyond the ordinary caution associated with high places.

Acropustulosis of Infancy

A recurrent itchy eruption of tiny vesicles and pustules, mainly on the palms and soles of infants and young children. Crops become less frequent and usually resolve by early childhood; scabies may precede or mimic it.

Acrosin

An enzyme released from the cap-like structure at a sperm's tip. It helps sperm pass through the egg's surrounding layers during fertilization, although successful fertilization requires many additional steps.

Acrosome

A cap-like structure on the head of a sperm cell containing enzymes that help it attach to and enter the egg during fertilization.

Acrosome Reaction

The release of enzymes from the cap at the front of a sperm cell after it contacts an egg. These enzymes help the sperm pass through the egg's outer coating; other steps are also needed for fertilization.

ACTH Blood Test

A blood test that measures the level of ACTH, a hormone made by the pituitary gland. It is usually checked with a cortisol test to help find problems of the adrenal or pituitary glands.

ACTH-Secreting Pituitary Adenoma

A usually noncancerous corticotroph tumor of the pituitary gland that produces excess adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH), causing Cushing disease. It may lead to weight gain around the trunk, high blood pressure, high blood sugar, muscle weakness, easy bruising, and other effects of prolonged cortisol excess.

ACTH Stimulation Test

A test that shows whether the adrenal glands can make cortisol. A synthetic form of ACTH is given, and cortisol levels are measured before and after it is given. A small rise may suggest adrenal insufficiency.

Actigraphy

Recording movement over days or weeks with a small wearable sensor, usually worn on the wrist. The pattern of movement helps estimate when a person is asleep or awake and how active they are, but it does not measure sleep directly and cannot by itself diagnose every sleep problem.

Alternate Names:
Actigraphic Monitoring

Actin

A protein that helps cells keep their shape and move. In muscle, actin works with myosin to produce contraction; in other cells, it supports movement, internal transport, and changes in cell structure.

Alternate Names:
Actin Filament; Microfilament Protein

Actin-Binding Protein

A protein that attaches to actin filaments and helps build, organize, move, or anchor the cell's internal framework. Examples include myosin, gelsolin, and alpha-actinin.

Acting Out

Expressing emotional conflict or distress through behavior rather than words.

Actinic

Relating to ultraviolet radiation from sunlight or UV lamps; chronic actinic exposure can cause sunburn, photoaging, and actinic keratoses.

Actinic Cheilitis

A precancerous sun-damage condition of the lips, usually the lower lip, caused by long-term ultraviolet exposure. It may cause persistent dryness, scaling, whitening, thickening, or blurring of the lip border and can progress to squamous cell carcinoma.

Actinic Granuloma

A usually harmless inflammatory skin condition that occurs on sun-damaged skin. It causes ring-shaped patches with a thinner center and a raised red border, most often on the neck, arms, or backs of the hands.

Actinic Keratosis

A rough, scaly, sandpaper-like lesion caused by cumulative ultraviolet damage, usually on sun-exposed skin such as the face, scalp, ears, neck, forearms, or hands. It is a keratinocytic precancer that may progress to cutaneous squamous-cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Solar Keratosis; AK; Senile Keratosis

Actinic Keratosis Pathology

Atypical keratinocytes with disordered maturation in the lower epidermis, often with parakeratosis, alternating orthokeratosis, and solar elastosis. It is a premalignant squamous lesion that can progress to cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma.

Actinic Purpura

Bruising caused by fragile, sun-damaged skin and connective tissue, usually on the backs of the hands and forearms in older adults. The purple patches may appear after minor trauma and are generally harmless, although medicines such as anticoagulants can worsen them.

Actin Myofilament

A thin muscle fiber made mainly of actin that interacts with myosin, allowing muscle cells to shorten and produce force during contraction and movement.

Alternate Names:
Thin Filament

Actinomycetoma

A slowly worsening bacterial infection of the skin and deeper tissue, usually affecting the foot after soil contamination. It causes swelling, firm lumps, draining channels, and grains in the discharge; untreated disease can damage bone.

Actinomycin D

Actinomycin D, or dactinomycin, is an antineoplastic antibiotic that blocks DNA-dependent RNA synthesis and is used for selected cancers; myelosuppression and tissue injury are important risks.

Actinomycosis

A chronic infection caused by Actinomyces bacteria, which normally live in the mouth and digestive and genital tracts. After entering deeper tissue, they can cause firm inflammatory masses and draining sinuses containing small yellow granules. The infection most often affects the face and neck, chest, or abdomen and pelvis and can resemble cancer.

Action Potential

A brief electrical signal that travels along a nerve or muscle cell. It begins when the cell's electrical charge changes enough to trigger the signal and allows nerves to communicate and muscles to contract.

Action Tremor

An involuntary rhythmic oscillation of a body part occurring during active voluntary muscle contraction. Subtypes include postural tremors (maintaining a position against gravity), kinetic tremors (moving through an arc), and intention tremors (worsening near the target).

Activated Charcoal

A porous form of carbon that adsorbs some substances in the gastrointestinal tract and can reduce their absorption after selected poisonings. It is not effective for every toxin and can cause aspiration or other complications.

Activated Partial Thromboplastin Time

A blood test that measures clotting through the intrinsic and common coagulation pathways. It may be prolonged by unfractionated heparin, clotting-factor deficiencies, inhibitors, or some liver and systemic disorders.

Activated Protein C Resistance

An inherited thrombophilic disorder characterized by an impaired anticoagulant response of plasma to activated protein C (APC). Approximately 90 to 95 percent of cases are caused by the factor V Leiden mutation (G1691A), which alters the APC cleavage site on factor V, predisposing affected individuals to recurrent deep venous thrombosis and pulmonary embolism.

Alternate Names:
APC Resistance

Active Caries

Tooth decay that is continuing to progress. The affected surface is often soft, rough, or chalky.

Active Management Of Third Stage

A set of measures used after birth to reduce postpartum hemorrhage, usually including a uterotonic medicine, controlled cord traction when appropriate, and assessment of uterine tone and bleeding.

Active Phase Of Labor

The part of the first stage of labor in which the cervix dilates progressively, generally beginning at about 6 cm and continuing to full dilation. Progress varies between individuals.

Active Site

The part of an enzyme where a target molecule attaches and a chemical reaction takes place. Its shape and chemical properties help the enzyme recognize particular molecules and change them into products.

Active Surveillance

Close, structured monitoring of a cancer or precancerous condition without immediate treatment. It includes scheduled examinations, laboratory tests, imaging, or biopsies, with treatment started if evidence of progression develops.

Active Transport

The movement of a substance across a cell membrane using cellular energy. It often moves the substance against a concentration or electrical gradient and helps cells control salts, nutrients, waste products, and other substances.

Activities Of Daily Living

Routine tasks required for personal care and independent living, including basic activities and more complex instrumental activities. Performance is assessed to describe functional status and support care planning.

Acupressure

A complementary treatment in which firm pressure is applied to selected points on the body, often with the fingers. It may provide short-term relief of symptoms such as nausea or pain, but evidence of benefit varies by condition.

Acupuncture

A treatment originating in traditional Chinese medicine in which thin needles are inserted into the skin and sometimes moved or electrically stimulated. It may help some pain conditions or treatment-related nausea, but benefits vary.

Acute

Describing symptoms or a condition that begins or worsens quickly and usually lasts a limited time. It is commonly contrasted with chronic, which develops or continues over a longer period.

Acute Abdomen

Sudden or severe abdominal pain with clinical features suggesting a potentially serious intra-abdominal disorder.

Acute Acalculous Cholecystitis

Acute gallbladder inflammation without gallstones, usually occurring in critically ill, injured, postoperative, or fasting patients. Ischaemia, bile stasis, and infection may contribute; it can progress rapidly to necrosis or perforation.

Acute Adrenal Crisis

A sudden, life-threatening shortage of adrenal hormones, especially cortisol, in a person with adrenal insufficiency. Infection, injury, surgery, or abrupt interruption of long-term glucocorticoids can precipitate it; manifestations include vomiting, abdominal pain, confusion, low blood pressure, and shock.

Acute Agitation

A state of heightened motor activity, emotional tension, irritability, and impaired behavioral control. It can occur with delirium, intoxication or withdrawal, medical illness, or psychiatric disorders.

Acute Alcohol Intoxication

Neurobehavioral and physiologic impairment caused by recent ethanol exposure. Severity varies with concentration, tolerance, co-ingestants, and comorbidity; dangerous effects include respiratory depression, aspiration, hypoglycemia, hypothermia, trauma, and coma.

Acute Angle-Closure Glaucoma

An ophthalmic emergency in which sudden closure of the anterior-chamber angle causes a rapid rise

in intraocular pressure. Severe eye pain, blurred vision, halos, headache, nausea, vomiting, and a red eye may occur; rapid pressure elevation can damage the optic nerve and threaten vision.

Acute Aortic Syndrome

A term for a group of sudden, life-threatening emergencies involving the wall of the aorta, the body's main artery. It includes a tear between the wall's layers (aortic dissection), bleeding within the wall without an open tear (intramural hematoma), or a deep ulcer penetrating the wall lining. These conditions typically cause sudden, severe, tearing chest or back pain and require urgent medical evaluation.

Alternate Names:
AAS

Acute Bacterial Prostatitis

A sudden bacterial infection of the prostate causing fever, chills, pain between the scrotum and anus or in the lower back, painful urination, and sometimes inability to pass urine. Prostate manipulation can trigger bacteremia, and severe infection may cause sepsis.

Acute Bacterial Rhinosinusitis

Bacterial infection of the paranasal sinuses suspected when symptoms persist without improvement for at least 10 days, worsen after initial improvement, or are severe, with fever of at least 39 °C and purulent nasal discharge or facial pain for 3–4 days. Viral infection is more common; duration and symptom pattern help distinguish the two.

Acute Basophilic Leukemia

A rare, aggressive acute myeloid leukemia in which immature basophil-lineage cells accumulate in the bone marrow and sometimes the blood. It can cause anemia, infections, bleeding, fever, bone pain, or other effects of marrow failure; diagnosis requires blood and marrow examination with immunophenotyping and genetic studies.

Acute Bilirubin Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction in a newborn caused by very high bilirubin levels. Poor feeding, sleepiness, weak muscle tone, irritability, a high-pitched cry, unusual movements, seizures, or coma may develop; severe cases can cause permanent brain injury.

Alternate Names:
Bilirubin Neurotoxicity

Acute Blood Loss

Rapid loss of blood that reduces circulating blood volume. It can cause weakness, a fast heart rate, low blood pressure, confusion, organ injury, or shock; the effects depend on the amount and rate of bleeding and the person's health.

Acute Bronchitis

Short-term inflammation of the large airways in the lungs, usually caused by a virus such as a cold or flu. It causes a cough that may bring up clear, yellow, or green mucus and may cause chest soreness, mild fever, tiredness, or wheezing. The cough often lasts 1 to 3 weeks; viruses cause most cases.

Alternate Names:
Chest Cold; Tracheobronchitis

Acute Bursitis

Sudden, acute inflammation of a synovial bursa, typically triggered by direct trauma, acute crystal deposition (gout/pseudogout), bacterial infection (most commonly *Staphylococcus aureus*), or unaccustomed repetitive strain. It presents with rapid-onset localized swelling, erythema, warmth, exquisite focal tenderness, and restricted active joint motion.

Alternate Names:
Acute Bursal Synovitis

Acute Caries

Tooth decay that progresses rapidly, often producing a soft lesion or cavity. Risk is increased by factors such as frequent sugar exposure, reduced saliva, or poor oral hygiene.

Acute Cerebellar Ataxia

Sudden or rapidly developing incoordination caused by cerebellar dysfunction. In children it may follow an infection; other causes include stroke, intoxication, inflammation, and tumor.

Acute Chest Syndrome

A potentially life-threatening pulmonary complication of sickle cell disease characterized by a new lung infiltrate plus fever or respiratory symptoms such as chest pain, cough, hypoxemia, or breathing difficulty.

Acute Cholangitis

Alternate name; see *Ascending Cholangitis*.

Acute Cholecystitis

Acute inflammation of the gallbladder, most often caused by persistent cystic-duct obstruction by a gallstone. It commonly causes sustained right-upper-quadrant pain, fever, nausea, vomiting, and a positive Murphy sign; diagnosis combines clinical, laboratory, and imaging findings, usually including ultrasound. Early laparoscopic cholecystectomy is generally preferred when appropriate, with drainage considered when surgery is unsafe.

Acute Colonic Pseudo-Obstruction

Severe widening of the large intestine without a physical blockage, usually in people who are seriously ill, injured, or recovering from surgery. It can cause pain, swelling, nausea, and vomiting. If it is not treated, the bowel may lose its blood supply or tear.

Alternate Names:
Ogilvie Syndrome; Colonic Pseudo-Obstruction

Acute Compartment Syndrome

A rapid rise in pressure inside a closed muscle compartment that reduces blood flow and can permanently damage muscles and nerves. It usually follows a fracture, crush injury, or severe swelling and can cause lasting loss of limb function.

Alternate Names:
ACS (acute compartment syndrome)

Acute Coronary Syndrome

A clinical spectrum of acute myocardial ischemia caused most often by coronary plaque disruption and thrombosis. It includes unstable angina, non-ST-elevation myocardial infarction (NSTEMI), and ST-elevation myocardial infarction (STEMI); ECG findings and serial cardiac troponin help distinguish these presentations.

Acute Coronary Syndromes

Another name for *Acute Coronary Syndrome*.

Acute Cough

A cough lasting less than three weeks. Common causes include viral respiratory infection, acute bronchitis, and pneumonia.

Acute Cutaneous Lupus Erythematosus (ACLE)

A lupus-specific inflammatory skin eruption that commonly presents as a transient malar or generalized erythematous rash, often triggered by sunlight and associated with systemic lupus activity. The malar rash usually spares the nasolabial folds; systemic manifestations may coexist.

Acute Cystitis

Acute bacterial infection and inflammation confined to the lower urinary tract and bladder mucosa, typically caused by uropathogenic *Escherichia coli* and presenting with acute dysuria, urinary frequency, urgency, suprapubic pain, and hematuria.

Alternate Names:
Acute Bacterial Cystitis; Bladder Infection

Acute Dacryocystitis

Acute infection and inflammation of the lacrimal sac, most commonly caused by obstruction of the nasolacrimal duct leading to stasis and secondary bacterial infection. It presents with painful swelling, redness, and tenderness at the medial canthus with purulent discharge.

Acute Decompensated Heart Failure

A sudden worsening of symptoms in someone with heart failure, occurring when the heart can no longer pump blood effectively enough to meet the body's needs. Fluid backs up into the lungs and other tissues, causing severe shortness of breath (especially when lying flat), rapid weight gain, swelling in the legs, and extreme fatigue.

Alternate Names:
ADHF; Acute Congestive Heart Failure

Acute Diarrhea

Passage of loose or watery stools, usually three or more times daily, lasting less than two weeks. Infection, food-related illness, medicines, and other intestinal disorders can cause it. Blood in stool, severe dehydration, persistent vomiting, or severe pain may accompany a more serious illness.

Acute Disease

An illness that begins suddenly or develops over a short period. It often lasts a limited time, although it can be mild, severe, or life-threatening and may sometimes lead to a longer-term condition.

Acute Disseminated Encephalomyelitis

A rare inflammatory condition of the brain and spinal cord that damages the protective myelin coating around nerve fibers. It typically develops one to three weeks after a viral or bacterial infection, or rarely after a vaccination, as an abnormal immune response. Symptoms usually come on quickly and include headache, fever, confusion, weakness, vision changes, or difficulty walking.

Alternate Names:
ADEM; Postinfectious Encephalomyelitis

Acute Ear Infection

A sudden, rapid-onset bacterial or viral infection of the middle ear space behind the eardrum, characterized by earache, fever, hearing muffled sounds, and bulging of the tympanic membrane.

Alternate Names:
Acute Otitis Media; AOM; Middle Ear Infection

Acute Endometritis

Acute inflammation of the endometrium, usually caused by ascending infection or retained tissue after pregnancy-related events or uterine instrumentation; fever, pelvic pain, and abnormal bleeding may occur.

Acute Epididymitis

Sudden inflammation of the epididymis, usually caused by infection and sometimes involving the testis. It causes unilateral scrotal pain and swelling; testicular torsion can cause similar symptoms.

Acute Epiglottitis

Alternate name; see *Epiglottitis*.

Acute Erythroid Leukemia

A rare, aggressive acute myeloid leukemia characterized by predominant neoplastic proliferation of immature erythroid cells with maturation arrest. In the 2022 WHO classification, it largely corresponds to what was previously called pure erythroid leukemia and is typically defined by erythroid predominance in the bone marrow, usually with at least 80% erythroid precursors and at least 30% proerythroblasts. The 2022 International Consensus Classification places comparable cases within the broader category of AML with mutated *TP53*; classification requires integrated morphologic, immunophenotypic, cytogenetic, and molecular assessment.

Alternate Names:
Pure Erythroid Leukemia (historical term)

Acute Esophageal Necrosis

A rare, severe condition in which the lining of the esophagus undergoes tissue death and appears black during endoscopy, usually in the lower third and ending abruptly where the esophagus meets the stomach. It often causes bleeding from the upper digestive tract. It is thought to result from a combination of reduced blood flow, injury from refluxed stomach contents, and weakened defenses of the lining.

Alternate Names:
Black Esophagus; Acute Necrotizing Esophagitis

Acute Exacerbation

A sustained, rapid worsening of a chronic disease beyond its usual day-to-day fluctuations. In chronic lung disease, it commonly causes increased breathlessness, cough, or sputum; respiratory infections and air pollution are common triggers, though other causes such as aspiration or pulmonary embolism may need consideration.

Acute Exacerbation Of Asthma

A progressive increase in dyspnea, cough, wheezing, or chest tightness with reduced expiratory airflow compared with the patient's baseline. Severe attacks may cause exhaustion, silent chest, hypercapnia, and respiratory failure.

Acute Exacerbation Of COPD

A sudden worsening of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, with more breathlessness, cough, or sputum than usual. It is often triggered by a respiratory infection, air pollution, or another stress on the lungs.

Acute Fatty Liver Of Pregnancy

A rare, potentially life-threatening liver disorder that usually develops late in pregnancy. Fat builds up in liver cells and may cause nausea, abdominal pain, jaundice, low blood sugar, abnormal bleeding, kidney failure, or other organ failure.

Acute Febrile Illness

A recent-onset illness with fever, often accompanied by chills, headache, muscle aches, or fatigue. Infection is a common cause; inflammatory diseases and reactions to medicines can also cause fever. The term describes a presentation, not a specific diagnosis.

Acute Febrile Neutrophilic Dermatosis

An inflammatory skin disease causing an abrupt eruption of tender, often edematous red or violaceous papules, plaques, or nodules. Fever and elevated blood neutrophils are common; associations include infection, inflammatory disease, pregnancy, certain medicines, and malignancy. A skin biopsy typically shows a dense neutrophil infiltrate without vasculitis.

Alternate Names:
Sweet Syndrome

Acute Fever in Adults

A recent-onset rise in body temperature in an adult, usually caused by infection and sometimes by inflammatory disease or a medicine reaction. Fever is a regulated increase in the body's temperature set point; overheating from heat exposure is hyperthermia, not fever.

Acute Flaccid Myelitis

A rare serious illness, usually in children, causing sudden weakness and limpness of one or more arms or legs. Facial weakness, swallowing difficulty, or breathing failure may occur.

Acute Gastritis

Sudden inflammation of the stomach lining. It may cause upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, or bleeding and can result from infection, medicines, alcohol, or severe illness. Some stomach injury from medicines or severe illness is gastropathy, in which there is little inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Acute Erosive Gastritis

Acute Generalized Exanthematous Pustulosis

A sudden skin reaction, usually to a medicine, that causes many small pus-filled bumps on widespread red skin. Fever may occur. It often starts within days of exposure and improves after the triggering medicine is stopped.

Acute Glomerulonephritis

Acute immune or infectious inflammation of the glomeruli producing a nephritic syndrome: hematuria with dysmorphic red cells or red-cell casts, variable proteinuria, edema, hypertension, and reduced kidney function. Causes include postinfectious disease, IgA nephropathy, vasculitis, and lupus; complement, serology, and sometimes kidney biopsy help identify the cause.

Acute Granulocytic Leukemia

Older term for acute myeloid leukemia; see *Acute Myeloid Leukemia*.

Acute Heart Failure

Rapid onset or worsening of heart-failure symptoms and signs, caused by pulmonary or systemic congestion, reduced cardiac output, or both. It may be a first episode or a sudden decompensation of

chronic heart failure and can range from worsening breathlessness or edema to pulmonary edema or cardiogenic shock.

Alternate Names:
Acute Decompensated Heart Failure; ADHF

Acute Hemorrhagic Edema of Infancy

A usually self-limited cutaneous small-vessel vasculitis of infants, characterized by fever, edema, and large bruise-like or targetoid purpuric lesions on the face and extremities. Internal-organ involvement is uncommon, and most cases resolve within one to three weeks.

Acute Hemorrhagic Leukoencephalitis

A rare, fulminant inflammatory demyelinating disease of the brain, considered a severe form of acute disseminated encephalomyelitis. It can cause rapidly worsening headache, fever, confusion, seizures, weakness, coma, and brain swelling.

Acute Hepatic Porphyria

A group of rare genetic metabolic disorders caused by enzymatic defects in the heme biosynthesis pathway in the liver. They are characterized by acute, life-threatening attacks of severe neurovisceral symptoms, including intense abdominal pain, autonomic instability, neuropathy, and psychiatric disturbances.

Alternate Names:
AHP

Acute Hepatitis

Sudden inflammation and injury of the liver, developing over days to months. It may cause tiredness, nausea, pain under the right ribs, dark urine, jaundice, or no symptoms. Causes include viruses, alcohol, medicines, toxins, and autoimmune disease.

Acute HIV Syndrome

A flu-like illness that may occur about 2–6 weeks after HIV infection, when the virus is multiplying rapidly. Fever, sore throat, swollen glands, rash, muscle aches, headache, nausea, diarrhea, or mouth ulcers may occur, but some people have no symptoms.

Acute Hypercapnic Respiratory Failure

A sudden inability to breathe out enough carbon dioxide, causing it to build up in the blood. Severe lung disease, asthma, weak breathing muscles, sedative medicines, or chest problems can cause confusion, sleepiness, or dangerous breathing failure.

Acute Hypoxemic Respiratory Failure

A sudden inability of the lungs to put enough oxygen into the blood. Pneumonia, fluid in the lungs, severe inflammatory lung injury, collapsed lung tissue, or a blood clot in the lungs may cause severe breathlessness, bluish skin, confusion, or organ injury.

Acute Idiopathic Polyneuritis

Guillain–Barré syndrome, an acute immune-mediated disorder of peripheral nerves that usually causes progressive symmetric weakness and reduced reflexes and may impair breathing.

Acute Illness

Alternate name; see *Acute Disease*.

Acute Inflammation

A rapid immune response to injury or infection that usually lasts hours to days. It can cause redness, warmth, swelling, pain, and reduced function as extra blood, fluid, and immune cells enter the affected area.

Acute Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyneuropathy

See *Guillain-Barre Syndrome*.

Acute Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyradiculoneuropathy

The most common form of Guillain–Barré syndrome. The immune system damages the protective covering of nerves, causing progressive weakness, tingling, and reduced reflexes that may spread to the breathing muscles.

Acute Intermittent Porphyria

An inherited disorder of haem production caused by

reduced hydroxymethylbilane synthase activity. Attacks may cause severe abdominal pain, nausea, constipation, dark urine, nerve symptoms, confusion, or seizures; medicines, hormonal changes, fasting, and illness can trigger them.

Acute Interstitial Nephritis

Sudden inflammation of the tissue between the kidney's filtering structures, most often caused by a reaction to a medicine. Infections and autoimmune disease can also cause it, leading to blood or protein in urine and a sudden decline in kidney function.

Acute Ischemic Stroke

Sudden loss of brain, spinal-cord, or retinal function because a blood vessel is blocked and the tissue does not receive enough oxygen. Brain imaging distinguishes ischemia from bleeding.

Acute Keratitis

Sudden inflammation of the cornea, the clear front layer of the eye. It may result from infection, injury, contact-lens wear, or other causes. Symptoms may include eye pain, redness, tearing, sensitivity to light, or blurred vision. Severe cases may cause a corneal ulcer.

Acute Kidney Injury

An abrupt decline in kidney function, defined by a serum-creatinine rise of at least 0.3 mg/dL within 48 hours, a rise to at least 1.5 times baseline within 7 days, or urine output below 0.5 mL/kg/hour for 6 hours. Causes are commonly prerenal hypoperfusion, intrinsic kidney injury, or postrenal obstruction; complications include azotemia, fluid and electrolyte disorders, and acidosis.

Alternate Names:
AKI; Acute Kidney Failure; Acute Renal Failure

Acute Kidney Injury Staging

The KDIGO classification grades acute kidney injury as stage 1, 2, or 3 using changes in serum creatinine or urine output; the more severe criterion determines the stage. Stage 1 includes a creatinine rise of at least 0.3 mg/dL within 48 hours or 1.5–1.9 times baseline within 7 days, or urine output below 0.5 mL/kg/h for 6–12 hours. Stage 2 includes creatinine 2.0–2.9 times baseline or urine output below 0.5 mL/kg/h for at least 12 hours. Stage 3 includes creatinine at least 3 times baseline, a level of at least 4.0 mg/dL, initiation of kidney replacement therapy, estimated glomerular filtration rate below 35 mL/min/1.73 m^2 in a person under 18, urine output below 0.3 mL/kg/h for at least 24 hours, or no urine output for at least 12 hours.

Acute Leukemia

A fast-growing blood cancer in which immature abnormal blood cells crowd the bone marrow and interfere with normal blood-cell production. It can cause anemia, infections, and bleeding.

Acute Limb Ischemia

Sudden reduction in arterial blood flow to a limb that threatens tissue viability, usually caused by embolism, thrombosis, or graft occlusion. The six classic findings are pain, pallor, pulselessness, paresthesia, paralysis, and poikilothermia; prolonged ischemia can result in tissue loss.

Acute Limb Ischemia Six Ps

Six findings of suddenly reduced artery blood flow to a limb: pain, paleness, absent pulse, tingling or numbness, weakness or paralysis, and a cold limb.

Acute Liver Failure

A rapid loss of liver function, developing within 26 weeks in someone without known cirrhosis or long-term liver disease. It causes poor blood clotting and changes in thinking or alertness (hepatic encephalopathy). Causes include some medicines or poisons, viral hepatitis, autoimmune hepatitis, and Wilson disease.

Alternate Names:
Fulminant Hepatic Failure (older term)

Acute Low Back Pain

Pain in the lower back lasting less than 6 weeks. Most cases are nonspecific, without a clearly identifiable structural cause; some are associated with muscle or ligament strain, disc disease, or other spinal conditions.

Alternate Names:
Acute Lumbago

Acute Lymphangitis

Acute inflammation of lymphatic vessels, typically caused by streptococcal or staphylococcal infection spreading from a wound. It causes red, tender streaks extending from the infection site toward nearby lymph nodes and may occur with fever or malaise.

Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia

A rapidly progressive cancer of immature B- or T-lymphoid cells (lymphoblasts) that accumulate in the bone marrow and may circulate in blood or involve lymph nodes, spleen, liver, or central nervous system. Marrow failure can cause anemia, infection, or bleeding.

Alternate Names:
ALL; Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia; Acute Lymphoid Leukemia

Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia

Alternate name; see *Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia*.

Acute Lymphoid Leukemia

Alternate name; see *Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia*.

Acute Megakaryoblastic Leukemia

A subtype of acute myeloid leukemia characterized by at least 20differentiation, identified by platelet-lineage markers such as CD41, CD42b, or CD61. It occurs in children and adults; childhood cases are strongly associated with Down syndrome.

Acute Mesenteric Ischemia

A sudden reduction in blood flow to the intestine that threatens bowel viability. Causes include arterial embolism or thrombosis, mesenteric venous thrombosis, and nonocclusive low-flow states. Severe abdominal pain may initially be disproportionate to examination findings; untreated ischemia can progress to bowel infarction, peritonitis, and shock.

Alternate Names:
AMI (acute mesenteric ischemia)

Acute Mitral Regurgitation

Sudden backward flow of blood from the left ventricle into the left atrium during systole, caused by acute leaflet, chordal, papillary-muscle, or ventricular injury. It can rapidly produce pulmonary edema, low cardiac output, or shock.

Acute Monocytic Leukemia

An older FAB classification term (AML-M5) for acute myeloid leukemia with monocytic differentiation. It involves abnormal immature monocytic cells in the bone marrow and blood and may cause anemia, infection, bleeding, or tissue infiltration such as gingival enlargement.

Alternate Names:
AML-M5

Acute Mountain Sickness

A high-altitude illness caused by inadequate acclimatization, usually after ascent above about 2,500 m (8,200 ft). It is characterized by headache plus symptoms such as nausea, loss of appetite, dizziness, fatigue, or disturbed sleep. Worsening symptoms, confusion, inability to walk normally, or breathlessness at rest indicate progression to life-threatening high-altitude cerebral or pulmonary edema.

Acute Myeloblastic Leukemia

See *Acute Myeloid Leukemia*.

Acute Myelogenous Leukemia

Older alternate name; see *Acute Myeloid Leukemia*.

Acute Myeloid Leukemia

A clonal hematopoietic neoplasm characterized by the rapid proliferation and accumulation of abnormal, poorly differentiated myeloid progenitor cells (blasts) in the bone marrow and peripheral blood. This suppresses normal hematopoiesis, leading to progressive cytopenias manifested as fatigue from anemia, recurrent or opportunistic infections from neutropenia, and petechiae, ecchymoses, or mucosal bleeding from thrombocytopenia.

Alternate Names:
AML; Acute Myelogenous Leukemia

Acute Myocardial Infarction

Death of heart muscle from acute ischemia. Diagnosis requires a rise or fall in cardiac troponin, with at least one value above the sex-specific 99th-percentile upper reference limit, together with clinical, electrocardiographic, imaging, or pathologic evidence of acute myocardial ischemia. Coronary atherothrombosis is a common cause, but infarction can also result from oxygen supply-demand imbalance or other coronary mechanisms.

Alternate Names:
AMI

Acute Myocardial Infarction Pathology

Histopathologic evolution of myocardial infarction, from early ischemic injury and coagulative necrosis through inflammation, granulation tissue, and scar formation. The findings depend on the interval between infarction and examination.

Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis

A painful, rapidly developing infection of the gums characterized by punched-out gingival papillae, ulceration, spontaneous bleeding, gray necrotic tissue, and foul breath. It is associated with anaerobic oral bacteria and risk factors such as poor oral hygiene, smoking, stress, malnutrition, or immunosuppression.

Alternate Names:
ANUG; Trench Mouth; Vincent Stomatitis

Acute Nephritic Syndrome

A clinical syndrome of glomerular inflammation marked by hematuria, variable proteinuria, edema, hypertension, and reduced kidney function.

Acute Nonlymphocytic Leukemia

Older term for acute myeloid leukemia; see *Acute Myeloid Leukemia*.

Acute Obstructive Uropathy

Sudden impairment of urinary flow caused by obstruction of the urinary tract, potentially producing hydronephrosis, pain, infection, and acute kidney injury.

Acute-On-Chronic Liver Failure

Sudden severe worsening of advanced chronic liver disease, causing liver failure and failure or dysfunction in one or more other organs. A 2026 global consensus defines liver failure using a bilirubin level of at least 5 mg/dL and a blood-clotting test (INR) of at least 1.5. It carries high short-term risk of death.

Acute Onset Pain

Pain that begins suddenly, often over seconds, minutes, or hours.

Alternate Names:
Sudden-Onset Pain

Acute Otitis Media

A sudden infection or inflammation in the space behind the eardrum, often after a cold. It can cause ear pain, fever, irritability, or temporary hearing loss; the eardrum may bulge because fluid or pus has built up behind it.

Acute Pain

Pain that begins suddenly and usually lasts for a limited period, often because of injury, illness, or a procedure.

Acute Pancreatitis

Sudden inflammation of the pancreas, most often caused by gallstones or alcohol. It usually causes severe upper-abdominal pain that may reach the back, with nausea or vomiting; complications can include fluid loss, infection, organ failure, or pancreatic collections.

Acute Pericarditis

Rapid-onset inflammation of the sac around the heart, often idiopathic or viral and sometimes related to autoimmune disease, heart injury, kidney disease, cancer, or medicines. It typically causes sharp chest pain that worsens with breathing or lying down and improves when sitting up and leaning forward; a friction rub, diffuse ST-segment elevation with PR-segment depression, or a pericardial effusion may occur.

Acute-Phase Reactants

A group of plasma proteins whose circulating concentrations increase or decrease by at least 25 percent during inflammatory states, tissue injury, or infection. Positive reactants include C-reactive protein, ferritin, fibrinogen, and hepcidin; negative reactants include albumin and transferrin.

Alternate Names:
Acute-Phase Proteins

Acute Poisoning

Harmful effects that develop after a short-term exposure to a toxic substance by swallowing, inhaling, injection, skin contact, or another route. Effects depend on the substance, amount, route, and time of exposure.

Acute Proctitis

Sudden inflammation of the rectal mucosa causing rectal pain, urgency, tenesmus, bleeding, mucus, or discharge. Infectious, inflammatory, ischemic, traumatic, and radiation-related causes are possible.

Acute Promyelocytic Leukemia

A subtype of acute myeloid leukemia usually defined by a PML::RARA fusion, most often from the t(15;17) chromosome translocation. It can rapidly cause life-threatening bleeding and clotting abnormalities from disseminated intravascular coagulation and fibrinolysis.

Acute Pulmonary Edema

Acute or rapidly worsening accumulation of fluid in the lungs; see *Pulmonary Edema*.

Acute Pulmonary Histoplasmosis

An acute lower respiratory tract infection caused by inhaling microconidia of the dimorphic fungus *Histoplasma capsulatum*, commonly found in soil enriched with bird or bat guano. Manifestations range from mild flu-like symptoms to severe pneumonia with mediastinal lymphadenopathy.

Alternate Names:
Primary Pulmonary Histoplasmosis; Acute Histoplasmosis Pneumonia

Acute Pyelonephritis

A sudden bacterial infection of the kidney, usually spreading upward from the bladder. It can cause fever, chills, pain in the side or back, nausea, and painful or frequent urination. In some cases it spreads to the bloodstream or impairs kidney function.

Acute Radiation Sickness

Illness caused by receiving a high dose of penetrating radiation over a short time, potentially damaging bone marrow, intestines, skin, and other organs.

Acute Radiation Syndrome

See *Radiation Sickness*.

Acute Rehabilitation

Multidisciplinary rehabilitation provided during or soon after hospitalization for conditions such as stroke, spinal-cord injury, traumatic brain injury, or major trauma. Its goals address functional impairment.

Acute Rejection

An immune injury to a transplanted organ or tissue caused by recipient T cells, donor-specific antibodies, or both. It may arise at various times after transplantation, so timing alone does not define it. The form of tissue damage and effects on graft function vary by organ.

Acute Renal Artery Occlusion

Sudden obstruction of blood flow through one or both main renal arteries or their primary branches, most commonly caused by thromboembolism, in situ thrombosis, or trauma. It presents with severe flank or abdominal pain, hematuria, refractory hypertension, and rapid deterioration of kidney function.

Acute Renal Failure

See *Acute Kidney Injury*.

Acute Respiratory Disease

A broad term for a recent-onset illness affecting the upper or lower respiratory tract. Examples include

a respiratory infection, an asthma attack, or lung injury from inhaled substances; the term alone does not name a specific diagnosis or cause.

Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome

A severe, life-threatening form of lung injury in which widespread inflammation causes fluid to leak into the lungs' microscopic air sacs (alveoli). This prevents the lungs from filling with air and stops sufficient oxygen from reaching the bloodstream. It develops rapidly—usually within a week of a major illness or injury such as severe pneumonia, sepsis, or physical trauma—causing intense shortness of breath and low blood oxygen levels.

Alternate Names:
ARDS; Noncardiogenic Pulmonary Edema

Acute Respiratory Failure

A sudden inability of the respiratory system to maintain adequate oxygenation, carbon-dioxide removal, or both. It may result from lung disease, airway obstruction, neuromuscular weakness, or impaired respiratory drive.

Acute Retinal Necrosis

A rapidly progressive necrotizing viral retinitis, usually caused by herpes viruses, with vitreous inflammation, peripheral retinal necrosis, occlusive vasculitis, and risk of retinal detachment.

Acute Retroviral Syndrome

The acute illness that may occur shortly after HIV infection, commonly involving fever, rash, sore throat, lymph-node enlargement, muscle aches, or headache.

Acute Rhinitis

Sudden inflammation of the nasal lining, commonly caused by a viral infection or an irritant, producing congestion, nasal discharge, and sneezing.

Acute Rhinosinusitis

See *Acute Sinusitis*.

Acute Sinusitis

Acute inflammation of the mucosa of one or more paranasal sinuses, usually following a viral upper-respiratory infection. It causes nasal obstruction, purulent or discoloured discharge, facial pressure or pain, and reduced smell; persistent, severe, or worsening symptoms may indicate acute bacterial rhinosinusitis or a complication.

Alternate Names:
Acute Rhinosinusitis; Paranasal Sinus Infection

Acute Stress Disorder

A trauma-related mental-health condition beginning after exposure to actual or threatened death, serious injury, or sexual violence and lasting from three days to one month. Symptoms may include intrusive memories, avoidance, negative mood, dissociation, and increased arousal.

Acute Symptomatic Hyponatremia

A recently developing low blood sodium concentration accompanied by symptoms, particularly neurologic symptoms such as headache, confusion, seizures, or reduced consciousness. Clinical significance depends on the sodium level, rate of change, underlying cause, and associated illness.

Acute Transverse Myelitis

Inflammation across a segment of the spinal cord that can cause rapidly developing weakness, sensory changes, and bladder or bowel dysfunction.

Acute Tubular Necrosis

A kidney disorder caused by damage to the cells lining the tiny filtering tubules of the kidneys. It is the most common cause of sudden kidney failure in hospitalized patients, typically triggered by a severe lack of blood flow and oxygen to the kidneys (such as during severe low blood pressure or shock) or by toxic exposure to certain medications or imaging contrast dyes. As damaged cells slough off and block the tubules, kidney function drops, leading to decreased urine production and buildup of waste products in the blood.

Alternate Names:
ATN; Acute Tubular Injury (ATI)

Acute Urinary Retention

Sudden inability to pass urine despite a full bladder, often causing severe lower-abdominal pain and swelling. Causes include blockage, medicines, nerve problems, or impaired bladder contraction.

Acute Viral Hepatitis

A short-term infection that inflames the liver, caused by a hepatitis virus. Hepatitis A and E usually cause acute infection; hepatitis B, C, and D can also become chronic, and hepatitis D occurs only with hepatitis B. Symptoms may include tiredness, nausea, right-upper-abdominal discomfort, dark urine, or jaundice, but some people have none.

Acute Viral Illness

A short-duration illness caused by a virus. Symptoms depend on the affected organ system and may include fever, fatigue, cough, vomiting, diarrhea, or rash.

Acute Vision Loss

Sudden reduction or loss of vision in one or both eyes caused by retinal vascular occlusion, retinal detachment, optic-nerve disease, stroke, acute glaucoma, inflammation, or trauma.

Acute Weeping Dermatitis

A form of acute dermatitis with inflamed, often blistered skin that releases clear or yellowish fluid and may form crusts. It is a descriptive pattern that can occur with contact dermatitis, eczema, infection, or other inflammatory skin disorders.

Acyanotic

Describes a person or congenital heart defect without visible cyanosis, the bluish discoloration caused by low blood oxygen. Acyanotic heart defects often involve left-to-right blood flow or an obstruction to blood leaving the heart. This label describes oxygenation or presentation, not the severity of the defect. Some defects that are acyanotic early in life can later reduce oxygen levels or cause cyanosis as circulation changes or the disease progresses.

Acyanotic Heart Disease

A broad category of congenital heart defects that do not usually cause visible cyanosis because systemic blood oxygenation is relatively preserved. It includes many left-to-right shunts, such as atrial or ventricular septal defects and patent ductus arteriosus, as well as obstructive lesions. These defects can still strain the heart or cause complications, including heart failure or pulmonary hypertension. The term groups different structural conditions and does not name one specific diagnosis.

Acyclovir

An antiviral drug that inhibits herpesvirus DNA polymerase and is used for infections caused by herpes simplex virus and varicella-zoster virus.

Alternate Names:
Aciclovir

Adactyly

Absence of one or more fingers or toes from birth.

ADA Deficiency

A rare inherited disorder in which cells lack enough adenosine deaminase, an enzyme needed to break down certain cell chemicals. Toxic substances then build up and damage immune cells, often causing severe infections from early infancy.

Adamantine

Very hard or resembling diamond; in dentistry, relating to tooth enamel or enamel-like tissue. The term may describe an unusually hard structure or the appearance of a lesion containing enamel-forming tissue.

Adamantinoma

A rare, low-grade malignant primary bone neoplasm with epithelial cells in an osteofibrous stroma. It usually arises in the anterior cortex of the tibial shaft and occasionally involves the fibula. It most often affects young adults and presents as a slow-growing painful swelling or pathological fracture. Radiographs show eccentric, multilocular, radiolucent cortical lesions with surrounding sclerosis. The tumor is resistant to chemotherapy and radiother-

apy.

Alternate Names:
Adamantinoma of Long Bones; Tibial Adamantinoma; Malignant Angioblastoma of Bone

Adam's Apple

The common name for the laryngeal prominence, the visible projection at the front of the neck formed by the angle where the two laminae of the thyroid cartilage meet.

Adams-Stokes Syndrome

A clinical syndrome characterized by sudden, transient episodes of syncope or loss of consciousness caused by abrupt bradyarrhythmias, high-grade or complete atrioventricular block, or ventricular asystole leading to acute cerebral hypoperfusion.

Alternate Names:
Stokes-Adams Syndrome; Adams-Stokes Attack

Adaptation

Adaptation is the adjustment of a cell, organism, or person to a changing internal or external condition; in medicine it may involve physiologic compensation, behavior, or rehabilitation.

Adaptive Design

A clinical-study design allowing planned changes based on accumulating data while preserving scientific validity. Changes may involve sample size, treatment groups, or enrollment and must follow a prespecified plan.

Adaptive Equipment

Tools or devices modified to help a person perform daily activities safely despite disability, weakness, pain, or sensory loss. Examples include bathroom rails, reachers, adapted utensils, wheelchairs, and communication aids.

Adaptive Immunity

The part of the immune system that learns to recognize specific germs or abnormal cells. B cells make targeted antibodies, T cells coordinate or destroy affected cells, and memory cells help produce a faster response to a later exposure.

ADD/ADHD

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder, a neurodevelopmental condition involving persistent inattention, hyperactivity, impulsivity, or combinations of these symptoms that impair functioning.

Addiction

A commonly used, non-diagnostic term for compulsive substance use or recurrent behavior despite harm, with impaired control, craving, or difficulty stopping. In clinical practice, the specific diagnosis is usually named as a substance-use disorder or a recognized disorder due to addictive behavior; physical dependence alone does not establish addiction.

Addison Anemia

An older name for pernicious anemia, a vitamin B12-deficiency megaloblastic anemia caused by inadequate intrinsic factor and impaired B12 absorption.

Alternate Names:
Addisonian Anemia; Addison's Anemia

Addison Disease

Primary adrenal insufficiency caused by failure or destruction of the adrenal cortex, leading to low cortisol and sometimes low aldosterone. Findings may include fatigue, weight loss, low blood pressure, salt craving, and darkened skin; severe cortisol deficiency can cause adrenal crisis.

Alternate Names:
Primary Adrenal Insufficiency; Primary Adrenocortical Insufficiency; Addison's Disease

Addisonian Anemia

Alternate name; see *Addison Anemia*.

Addisonian Crisis

Life-threatening emergency resulting from acute cortisol deficiency in patients with adrenal insufficiency. Precipitated by infection, trauma, surgery, or abrupt discontinuation of chronic glucocorticoid therapy.

Additive Genetic Effects

The contributions of individual alleles that combine approximately additively to influence a measurable trait, without requiring interaction between those alleles.

Adduct

To move an arm, leg, finger, toe, or other body part toward the center line of the body.

Adduction

Movement of a body part toward the body's midline or, for a finger or toe, toward the hand or foot's central axis. For example, bringing an arm back toward the side is shoulder adduction.

Adductor Muscle

A muscle that moves a body part toward the body's midline or, for a digit, toward the axis of the hand or foot.

Adductor Muscles

The medial compartment muscle group of the thigh (comprising adductor longus, adductor brevis, adductor magnus, gracilis, and pectineus) that draws the lower extremity toward the midline and stabilizes the pelvis; strain of these muscles is a frequent cause of athletic groin pain. See also: *Adductor Muscle*.

Adductor Muscle Strain

An overstretch or small tear in an inner-thigh muscle that draws the leg toward the body's midline. It often causes groin or inner-thigh pain, especially during running, kicking, or changing direction.

Adenine

A purine nitrogenous nucleobase that forms complementary base pairs with thymine in DNA (via two hydrogen bonds) and with uracil in RNA. It also forms essential components of adenosine, cellular energy carriers (ATP, ADP, AMP), second messengers (cAMP), and key metabolic cofactors (NAD+, FAD).

Alternate Names:
6-Aminopurine; Ade

Adenitis

Inflammation of a gland or lymph node, usually caused by infection or an immune-mediated disease. It may cause localized swelling, tenderness, redness, or fever. The affected structure and underlying cause shape the clinical features. Adenitis may be acute or chronic, depending on its duration.

Adenocarcinoma

A cancer made of cells that form glands or have gland-like features. It can start in many organs, including the bowel, breast, lung, pancreas, prostate, stomach, or uterus.

Adenocarcinoma Cancers

Alternate name; see *Adenocarcinoma*.

Alternate Names:
Glandular Cancers; Adenocarcinomas

Adenocarcinoma In Situ Of Cervix

A noninvasive glandular precursor lesion of the cervix, usually associated with high-risk human papillomavirus; abnormal glandular cells remain confined to the epithelium but may progress to invasive adenocarcinoma.

Adenocarcinoma Of The Colon

A malignant gland-forming epithelial tumor of the colon, commonly presenting with altered bowel habits, occult bleeding, anemia, or an obstructing mass.

Adenocarcinoma Of The Lung

The most common type of non-small-cell lung cancer. It begins in gland-forming cells, often toward the outer lung, and can occur in smokers or nonsmokers. Some tumors have gene changes, such as EGFR, ALK, or KRAS, that guide treatment choices.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonary Adenocarcinoma; Bronchial Adenocarcinoma

Adenohypophysis

The front part of the pituitary gland, a small hormone-producing organ at the base of the brain. It releases hormones that regulate growth, thyroid activity, adrenal function, reproduction, milk production, and other body processes.

Adenoid Basal Carcinoma

A rare, usually indolent cervical carcinoma composed of small basaloid nests, often associated with squamous intraepithelial lesions and requiring distinction from more aggressive tumors.

Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma

A rare malignant cancer that arises in secretory glands, most commonly the major and minor salivary glands of the head and neck, as well as the breast, skin, and airways. It tends to grow slowly but is notable for tracking along nerve pathways (perineural invasion), causing pain or numbness, and recurring or spreading to the lungs years after initial treatment.

Alternate Names:
Cylindroma

Adenoid Cystic Carcinoma Of The Vulva

A rare malignant tumor of vulvar Bartholin-type glands, often causing pain because of perineural invasion. It is usually slow-growing but may recur locally or metastasize after long intervals.

Adenoidectomy

Surgical removal of the adenoids, a patch of lymphatic tissue behind the nose. In children, it may be used for persistent nasal obstruction, obstructive sleep apnea, or selected cases of recurrent middle-ear disease or chronic rhinosinusitis.

Alternate Names:
Adenoid Excision; Adenoid Removal

Adenoid Hyperplasia

Alternate name; see *Adenoid Hypertrophy*.

Adenoid Hypertrophy

Enlargement of the adenoids, a patch of tissue behind the nose at the top of the throat. It is common in children and may happen during or after an infection. Enlarged adenoids can block nasal breathing and cause mouth breathing, snoring, disturbed sleep, pauses in breathing during sleep, or fluid behind the eardrum and repeated ear infections.

Alternate Names:
Enlarged Adenoids; Adenoidal Hyperplasia; Adenoid Hyperplasia

Adenoiditis

Acute or chronic inflammation and infection of the adenoid tissue behind the nose. It causes persistent nasal congestion, purulent nasal discharge, mouth breathing, snoring, sore throat, and muffled speech.

Adenoid Removal

Alternate name; see *Adenoidectomy*.

Adenoids

A collection of lymphatic tissue located in the upper airway at the back of the nasopharynx, forming part of Waldeyer's ring. In infants and young children, they help sample and trap inhaled germs to build immunity, but typically shrink in size during late childhood and adolescence.

Alternate Names:
Pharyngeal Tonsil; Nasopharyngeal Tonsil

Adenolipoma

A benign tumor composed of glandular cells and mature fat cells. It may occur in the skin, breast, thyroid, parathyroid, or salivary glands.

Adenolymphoma

A benign salivary-gland tumor, also called Warthin tumor, composed of oncocytic epithelium and lymphoid stroma and occurring most often in the parotid gland.

Alternate Names:
Warthin Tumor; Papillary Cystadenoma Lymphomatosum

Adenoma

A usually noncancerous gland-forming tumor aris-

ing from epithelial tissue. Some adenomas produce hormones or other secretions, and some—especially certain colon and rectal adenomas—contain precancerous changes and may later become cancerous.

Adenoma-Carcinoma Sequence

The usual step-by-step pattern in which some colon polyps develop genetic changes, become increasingly abnormal, and eventually turn into colon cancer over several years. Removing suitable polyps can interrupt this progression.

Adenoma Malignum

An older name for minimal-deviation adenocarcinoma, a rare, well-differentiated, invasive, mucus-producing cancer of the cervix. Its cells may look nearly normal under the microscope, making diagnosis difficult.

Adenomatosis

A condition in which multiple gland-forming tumors called adenomas develop in one organ or tissue. The tumors are often benign, but their number and location may affect cancer risk.

Adenomatous Polyp

A benign gland-forming polyp, most commonly in the colon, that may contain dysplasia and can progress through the adenoma–carcinoma sequence. Tubular, villous, and tubulovillous types are recognized.

Adenomatous Polyposis

Alternate name; see *Familial Adenomatous Polyposis*.

Adenomyoepithelioma Of The Breast

A rare biphasic breast tumor composed of proliferating epithelial and myoepithelial cells. Most are benign, but local recurrence can occur, and a small proportion develop malignant features or metastasize.

Adenomyoma

A benign uterine lesion composed of endometrial glands and stroma within a proliferation of smooth muscle; it may cause abnormal uterine bleeding or mimic other uterine tumors.

Adenomyosis

A condition in which tissue like the lining of the uterus grows into its muscular wall. It may make the uterus larger and cause heavy periods, strong cramps, or ongoing pelvic pain. Some people have no symptoms.

Adenopathy

Disease or enlargement of a gland, most often used for lymph-node enlargement or abnormal lymph-node involvement.

Adenosarcoma

A malignant mixed tumor containing benign gland-forming epithelial tissue and a malignant connective-tissue component. The term most often refers to Müllerian adenosarcoma of the uterus, but similar tumors can arise in other organs. It may recur locally, while spread to distant sites is less common.

Adenosine

A purine nucleoside made of adenine linked to ribose that participates in energy transfer and cell signaling. Given rapidly by injection, it can briefly slow conduction through the atrioventricular node and is used for selected supraventricular tachycardias.

Adenosine Deaminase Deficiency

A rare inherited genetic disorder caused by a lack of the adenosine deaminase enzyme, which is needed to break down metabolic waste in cells. Without this enzyme, toxic byproducts build up and destroy developing white blood cells (lymphocytes), leading to a severely weakened immune system. It is one of the primary causes of severe combined immunodeficiency (SCID), leaving affected infants highly vulnerable to frequent and life-threatening infections.

Alternate Names:
ADA Deficiency; ADA-SCID

Adenosine Deaminase Severe Combined

Immunodeficiency (ADA-SCID)

A severe combined immune deficiency caused by inherited adenosine deaminase deficiency. Toxic purine metabolites prevent normal development and function of T and B lymphocytes, leaving affected infants highly vulnerable to severe or recurrent infections.

Adenosine Diphosphate

A nucleotide formed when ATP loses one phosphate group. ADP can be converted back to ATP to support cellular energy use, and released ADP also activates nearby platelets and promotes platelet aggregation during clot formation.

Alternate Names:
ADP

Adenosine Monophosphate

A small molecule made of adenine, ribose, and one phosphate group. It is formed when cells break down or recycle energy-carrying molecules and helps regulate energy use and cell signaling.

Alternate Names:
AMP; Adenylic Acid

Adenosine Triphosphate

The main short-term energy source inside cells. Cells make it from nutrients and use it to power muscle contraction, movement of substances across cell membranes, chemical reactions, and many other essential processes.

Alternate Names:
ATP

Adenosis

An abnormal change involving a gland or glandular tissue, often an increase in the number or size of its glandular units. In the breast, adenosis refers to enlarged or increased milk-producing lobules and is benign; in other organs, the specific meaning depends on the named tissue and subtype.

Adenosis Of The Breast

A benign breast change in which the milk-producing lobules are larger or more numerous than usual. Sclerosing adenosis is a distinct pattern in which scar-like tissue forms in the lobules.

Adenovirus

A group of DNA viruses that commonly cause respiratory illness, including cold-like symptoms, sore throat, fever, bronchitis, croup, or pneumonia. Depending on the type, adenoviruses can also cause conjunctivitis, gastroenteritis, cystitis, or rarely neurologic disease. They spread through respiratory secretions, close contact, contaminated surfaces, and fecal–oral exposure. Most infections are mild, but severe disease is more likely in infants, people with heart or lung disease, and people with weakened immune systems.

Adenovirus DNA PCR (Feces)

A stool test that uses polymerase chain reaction (PCR) to detect adenovirus genetic material. It can help identify adenovirus in someone with a compatible illness; a positive result is interpreted with symptoms because viral DNA may sometimes be detected without illness.

Alternate Names:
Stool Adenovirus PCR; Adenovirus PCR, Stool

Adenovirus Infection

Illness caused by an adenovirus, commonly with sore throat, cough, fever, pink eye, diarrhea, or vomiting, especially in children. The virus spreads through droplets, close contact, contaminated surfaces, or infected stool. One pattern, pharyngoconjunctival fever, brings sore throat, red eyes, and fever together and spreads easily in daycare or swimming-pool settings. Most infections clear on their own, but severe breathing or widespread disease can occur in infants, older adults, people with heart or lung disease, and people with weak immune systems.

Adenylate Cyclase

An enzyme that changes ATP into cyclic AMP, a chemical messenger inside cells. It is often activated by signals received at the cell surface and helps control many cell functions.

Alternate Names:
Adenylyl Cyclase

Adequate Intake

A formal nutritional reference standard within the Dietary Reference Intakes (DRI) system. It represents the recommended average daily nutrient intake level based on observed or experimentally determined approximations in healthy populations, used when scientific evidence is insufficient to calculate an Estimated Average Requirement (EAR) and Recommended Dietary Allowance (RDA) (such as for vitamin K, potassium, or infant nutrition).

Alternate Names:
AI

ADHD in Children

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder in childhood, characterized by developmentally inappropriate inattention, hyperactivity, or impulsivity across settings. Diagnosis requires persistent impairment and information from caregivers, teachers, and clinical assessment.

ADHD in Women

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder manifesting in females, who frequently present with predominantly inattentive symptoms, internal restlessness, disorganization, and emotional dysregulation rather than prominent physical hyperactivity.

Alternate Names:
Female ADHD; ADHD in Adult Women

Adherence

The extent to which a person's behavior corresponds with agreed healthcare recommendations, including taking medications, following diets, or executing lifestyle changes. Non-adherence may stem from adverse effects, regimen complexity, cognitive impairment, financial constraints, or lack of support.

Alternate Names:
Compliance; Treatment Adherence; Medication Adherence

Adherens Junction

A connection that helps neighboring cells stick together. It links proteins on one cell to the internal support fibers of another, helping tissues keep their shape, strength, and protective barrier.

Adhesiolysis

A procedure that cuts or removes bands of scar tissue that abnormally join organs or body surfaces. It may relieve pain or release a blocked intestine, but the bands can form again after surgery.

Adhesion

A band of scar-like tissue that abnormally joins internal surfaces or organs, often after surgery, infection, inflammation, or injury, sometimes causing pain or blockage.

Adhesion Molecules

Proteins on cells that help cells attach to one another or to the material supporting them. They help organize tissues, guide immune cells to inflamed areas, and can influence how cancer spreads.

Adhesive Capsulitis

Alternate name; see *Frozen Shoulder*.

Adhesive Capsulitis Of The Hip

A rare condition in which the capsule around the hip joint becomes thick and tight, causing pain and reduced movement. The term is less established for the hip than for the shoulder, so other causes of hip stiffness must be considered.

Adhesive Tape

A material used to secure dressings, devices, or tubing to the skin. It is available in paper, cloth, plastic, and other forms.

Adie Syndrome

A neurological condition characterized by a tonically dilated pupil (Adie pupil) that reacts sluggishly to light but constricts more completely to near focus, accompanied by diminished or absent deep tendon reflexes, typically at the Achilles and patellar tendons.

Alternate Names:
Holmes-Adie Syndrome; Adie Pupil Syndrome

Adie Tonic Pupil

A pupil that is unusually large and reacts slowly to

light but constricts better when focusing on a near object. It usually affects one eye and results from injury to nerves controlling the pupil; the cause may be unknown or related to another disorder.

Adipocere

A grayish-white, waxy, soap-like substance formed in decomposing bodies exposed to moisture and lack of oxygen (such as damp soil or submerged water). It is produced by the bacterial hydrolysis and hydrogenation of body fats into fatty acids (saponification). This process retards putrefaction and can preserve body contours, facial features, and traumatic injuries for months or years, assisting forensic identification.

Alternate Names:
Grave Wax; Saponification Wax; Mortuary Wax

Adipocyte

A fat cell that stores energy and releases hormones and other signals affecting appetite, blood sugar, inflammation, and metabolism. White fat mainly stores energy, while brown and beige fat can produce heat; enlarged or excessive fat cells can contribute to insulin resistance.

Adipocytes

Plural form; see *Adipocyte*.

Adipogenesis

The process by which immature cells develop into fat cells. It helps form and maintain body-fat tissue, which stores energy and produces hormones; abnormal increases in the number or size of fat cells can contribute to obesity and metabolic disease.

Adipokine

A chemical messenger released by body fat. Adipokines help control appetite, blood sugar, fat use, inflammation, blood pressure, and immune activity; abnormal levels may contribute to obesity, diabetes, and heart or blood-vessel disease.

Adiponectin

A hormone produced mainly by fat cells that helps regulate fatty-acid use, glucose metabolism, insulin sensitivity, and inflammation. Levels are often lower with obesity and insulin resistance, but a blood level is not diagnostic by itself.

Adipose

Relating to body fat or composed of adipose tissue, which stores energy and also functions as an endocrine and immune-active organ.

Adipose Tissue

A specialized connective tissue composed mainly of adipocytes that store energy as triglycerides. It provides thermal insulation, cushioning for organs, and endocrine regulation through hormones and signaling molecules such as leptin and adiponectin.

Adiposis Dolorosa

Adiposis dolorosa, or Dercum disease, is a rare disorder characterized by painful fatty deposits, often with obesity, fatigue, and other systemic symptoms.

Adiposity

The amount and location of body fat. Too much body fat, especially around the abdomen, can increase the risk of diabetes, heart disease, high blood pressure, and joint or movement problems.

Adipsia

Little or no feeling of thirst despite the body needing fluid. It can lead to dehydration and dangerously high blood sodium, especially when caused by illness affecting the brain, medicines, aging, or severe illness.

Adjacent

Next to, close to, or sharing a boundary with another structure, tissue, organ, or lesion. The term helps describe location, spread of disease, or relationships seen on imaging or examination.

Adjustment Disorder

Emotional or behavioral symptoms in response to an identifiable stressor, beginning within three months of the stressor. The symptoms cause significant distress or impairment and do not meet criteria for

another mental disorder. They generally do not persist for more than six months after the stressor or its consequences have ended.

Adjustment Disorders

Alternate index label; see *Adjustment Disorder*.

Adjustment Disorder With Anxiety

An emotional or behavioral response to an identifiable stressor, with prominent anxiety symptoms such as worry, nervousness, or separation anxiety. Symptoms begin within three months of the stressor, cause distress out of proportion to the stressor or significant functional impairment, and do not meet criteria for another mental disorder; they generally resolve within six months after the stressor or its consequences end.

Adjuvant

An added treatment or substance that enhances the effect of a primary treatment; in vaccines, an adjuvant strengthens the immune response to an antigen.

Adjuvant Chemotherapy

Systemic antineoplastic drug therapy administered following definitive primary treatment, such as complete surgical tumor resection, designed to eradicate occult micrometastatic disease and reduce the risk of cancer recurrence.

Adjuvant Therapy

Additional treatment given after the main treatment to reduce the chance of disease returning. Examples include chemotherapy, radiation, hormone treatment, or immune treatment after surgery for selected cancers.

Adlerian Theory

A psychological theory developed by Alfred Adler, also called individual psychology. It emphasizes feelings of inferiority, goal-directed striving, a person's style of life, and social interest—the capacity to belong to and contribute to the community. Early family experiences and relationships are considered important influences on development.

Alternate Names:
Individual Psychology

Ad Lib

A prescription or clinical instruction meaning as desired or as tolerated, from the Latin ad libitum.

ADME

The four processes that describe what the body does to a medicine: absorption into the bloodstream, distribution through tissues, chemical breakdown, and excretion from the body. These processes influence a medicine's dose, timing, and effects.

Administered Activity

The measured amount of radioactive material given to a patient for a scan or treatment. The amount is recorded with the radioactive substance, method, date, and time so the exposure and treatment can be checked safely.

Administration Procedure

A method used to give a medicine, fluid, vaccine, nutrition, or other treatment, such as by mouth, injection, inhalation, skin application, or infusion. The method affects speed, dose, and risks.

Adnexa

Structures next to an organ. In gynecology, the uterine adnexa are the ovaries, fallopian tubes, and supporting ligaments and tissues around the uterus.

Adnexal Dysplasia

Abnormal development or organization of skin appendages, such as hair follicles or oil and sweat glands. The term describes a tissue finding; its significance depends on the affected structure and microscopic pattern and does not by itself establish cancer.

Adnexal Mass

A growth or enlargement involving structures beside the uterus, such as an ovary or fallopian tube.

Adnexal Torsion

Twisting of an ovary, fallopian tube, or both around their supporting tissues. The twist can reduce or stop blood flow. It usually causes sudden one-sided pelvic pain, often with nausea or vomiting; prolonged torsion can damage ovarian tissue.

Adnexal Tumors

Tumors arising in structures beside the uterus, especially the ovaries, fallopian tubes, or supporting tissues. They may be benign, borderline, or malignant and are evaluated with examination, imaging, laboratory tests, and sometimes surgery or biopsy.

Adnexal Tumors And Masses

Abnormal growths or masses involving the ovary, fallopian tube, or nearby supporting tissues; they may be benign or malignant.

Adnexitis

Inflammation of one or more uterine adnexa, usually the fallopian tubes and sometimes the ovaries. It commonly occurs as part of pelvic inflammatory disease and may cause lower abdominal pain, fever, abnormal discharge, or pain during sex; untreated infection can lead to an abscess, infertility, or ectopic pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Salpingo-Oophoritis

Adolescence

The developmental period between childhood and adulthood, involving physical maturation, puberty, and major psychological and social changes.

Adolescent Development

The physical, cognitive, emotional, and social changes that occur as a person develops from childhood into adulthood, including puberty and the development of greater independence.

Adolescent Health

The health and wellbeing of young people (10-19 years), addressing the physical, psychological, and social transitions of puberty and adolescence.

Adolescent Medicine

The medical specialty focused on health and development during adolescence and young adulthood. It addresses physical, mental, behavioral, reproductive, and social health, including growth, chronic disease, sexuality, nutrition, and substance use. Care is developmentally appropriate and may support transition to adult services.

Adolescent Obesity

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric Obesity*.

Adolescent Schizophrenia

Schizophrenia diagnosed with onset during adolescence. It is uncommon and may disrupt thinking, perception, emotions, and functioning at school or with peers; diagnosis requires a persistent pattern and exclusion of mood, substance-related, neurologic, and other causes of psychosis.

Adolescent Substance Use

Harmful or risky use of alcohol, nicotine, or other drugs during adolescence, including nonmedical use of prescription medicines. It can affect development, health, school performance, and relationships and may be associated with a substance use disorder.

Adoptive Cell Therapy

A personalized cellular immunotherapy in which a patient's own lymphocytes are expanded or engineered ex vivo and reinfused to attack the tumor; examples include tumor-infiltrating lymphocyte (TIL) therapy and chimeric antigen receptor (CAR) T-cell therapy.

Adoptive Immunotherapy

Treatment in which immune cells are collected, activated or genetically modified, and returned to the patient to attack disease, especially cancer. Fever, inflammation, and other immune reactions may occur.

ADP-Ribosylation

A chemical change in which a small molecule is attached to a protein or other cell molecule. This can switch the molecule's activity on or off and is

used by normal cell processes and by some bacterial toxins.

Adrenal Adenoma

A benign, noncancerous tumor arising from the cortex of the adrenal gland. While many are nonfunctioning and cause no symptoms, some oversecrete adrenal hormones such as aldosterone (causing Conn syndrome) or cortisol (causing Cushing syndrome).

Alternate Names:
Adrenocortical Adenoma

Adrenal Cancer

A rare cancer that begins in one of the adrenal glands above the kidneys. Some tumors start in the outer cortex and others in the inner medulla; some produce excess hormones, while others cause pain or other symptoms as they grow.

Adrenal Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor arising from the adrenal cortex. It may produce excess cortisol, aldosterone, androgens, or estrogens, or present as an incidental mass or pressure symptom; hormonal evaluation and imaging help guide diagnosis and staging.

Adrenal Cortex

The outer part of each adrenal gland that produces steroid hormones, including cortisol, aldosterone, and adrenal androgens. These hormones help regulate stress responses, blood pressure, salt balance, and metabolism.

Adrenal Cortex Physiology

The outer layer of each adrenal gland makes hormones that control salt and blood pressure, stress responses, metabolism, and some sexual development. Its activity is regulated by the kidneys, blood potassium, and the brain's hormone-control system.

Adrenal Cortical Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Adrenocortical Carcinoma*.

Adrenal Crisis

A sudden, life-threatening shortage of adrenal hormones, especially cortisol. It may occur with severe adrenal disease or after abruptly stopping long-term steroid treatment, particularly during infection, injury, or surgery. Symptoms can include severe weakness, vomiting, abdominal pain, confusion, low blood pressure, and collapse.

Adrenalectomy

Surgery to remove one or both adrenal glands, usually for a tumor or severe hormone overproduction. Removing one gland may leave enough hormone production; removal of both causes lifelong adrenal hormone deficiency requiring replacement.

Adrenal Failure

Alternate name; see *Adrenal Insufficiency*.

Adrenal Gland

One of two hormone-producing glands above the kidneys. The outer cortex makes aldosterone, cortisol, and adrenal androgens; the inner medulla makes adrenaline and noradrenaline. Adrenal hormones help regulate blood pressure, metabolism, stress responses, and salt balance.

Adrenal Gland Cancer

Alternate name; see *Adrenal Cancer*.

Adrenal Gland Disorders

A broad spectrum of conditions affecting the hormone production or structural integrity of the adrenal glands, leading to either deficient hormone output (such as Addison disease) or hormone excess (such as Cushing syndrome, primary aldosteronism, or pheochromocytoma).

Alternate Names:
Adrenal Diseases; Adrenocortical Disorders

Adrenal Gland Removal

Alternate name; see *Adrenalectomy*.

Adrenal Glands

Plural form; see *Adrenal Gland*.

Adrenal Gland Tumor

A growth in one of the adrenal glands above the kidneys. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and may or may not produce hormones; a pheochromocytoma is one possible type.

Adrenal Hemorrhage

Bleeding into an adrenal gland, often associated with severe infection, serious illness, a bleeding disorder, blood-thinning medicines, or injury. Bleeding into both glands can cause sudden loss of adrenal hormones, very low blood pressure, and shock.

Adrenal Hyperplasia

Growth of extra cells in one or both adrenal glands, making them larger. When the outer layer (adrenal cortex) is affected, hormone production may change. Effects depend on which hormones are affected and may include early puberty, excess body hair, high blood pressure, or changes in body salts.

Alternate Names:
Adrenocortical Hyperplasia; Adrenal Cortical Hyperplasia

Adrenal Incidentaloma

An unexpected mass found in an adrenal gland during imaging for another reason. It may be benign or cancerous and may or may not produce hormones, so evaluation usually includes imaging review and selected hormone tests.

Adrenaline

Alternate name; see *Epinephrine*.

Adrenal Insufficiency

A condition in which the adrenal glands do not make enough cortisol and sometimes not enough aldosterone. It can result from a problem in the adrenal glands or in the pituitary or hypothalamus, which help control them. It may cause tiredness, weakness, weight loss, low blood pressure, or changes in the body's salt balance. A severe shortage can cause an adrenal crisis.

Alternate Names:
Adrenocortical Hypofunction; Adrenal Cortical Hypofunction; Hypoadrenalism

Adrenal Mass

An abnormal growth or enlargement in or near an adrenal gland. It may be benign or cancerous and may or may not produce hormones; evaluation usually involves imaging and, when appropriate, hormone tests and specialist review.

Adrenal Medulla

The inner part of each adrenal gland, which sits above a kidney. It releases adrenaline and noradrenaline during stress, helping increase heart rate, blood pressure, alertness, and blood flow to muscles.

Adrenal Medulla Physiology

The inner part of each adrenal gland releases adrenaline and noradrenaline when the body's stress-response nerves are activated. These hormones quickly increase alertness, heart activity, blood pressure, and blood flow to muscles.

Adrenal Myelolipoma

A usually benign adrenal tumor composed of mature fat and blood-forming tissue. It is often found incidentally on imaging and causes no symptoms, but larger lesions may produce mass effect or bleeding. Management depends on size, symptoms, growth, and diagnostic certainty.

Adrenal Nodule

A localized lump in an adrenal gland. It may be a harmless nonfunctioning growth, a hormone-producing tumor, or rarely cancer; assessment depends on its size, imaging features, growth, and hormone production.

Adrenal Tumors

Growths arising in the adrenal cortex or medulla. They may be benign or malignant and may or may not produce hormones. Some are discovered incidentally; others cause symptoms through hormone excess or pressure on nearby structures. Their effects vary with tumor type, hormone activity, size, and location.

Adrenal Venous Sampling

A catheter-based test that measures hormones in

blood from each adrenal gland. It helps determine whether one gland is producing too much aldosterone, which can guide treatment for difficult-to-control high blood pressure.

Adrenarche

An early stage of sexual development, typically occurring around age six to eight, marked by increased production and secretion of weak adrenal androgens (such as dehydroepiandrosterone) by the zona reticularis of the adrenal cortex. It contributes to early pubic hair growth, axillary odor, and oily skin.

Adrenergic Agent

A medicine or substance that stimulates or blocks receptors responding to adrenaline (epinephrine) and noradrenaline (norepinephrine). These agents can change heart rate, blood pressure, airway size, and pupil size.

Adrenergic Agonist

A medicine or substance that copies the effects of adrenaline or noradrenaline by activating specific cell receptors. Depending on the receptor, it may raise blood pressure, speed the heart, open the airways, or improve heart pumping.

Alternate Names:
Sympathomimetic

Adrenergic Antagonists

Medicines or other substances that block adrenaline-like signaling at alpha or beta adrenergic receptors. They can lower blood pressure, slow the heart, reduce cardiac workload, or relax smooth muscle; effects and risks depend on the receptor targeted and the medicine used.

Alternate Names:
Adrenergic Blockers

Adrenergic Bronchodilator Overdose

Excess exposure to a medicine that opens the airways by stimulating the body's stress-response system. It may cause shaking, agitation, headache, fast heartbeat, low potassium, chest pain, or abnormal rhythms.

Adrenergic Receptor

A cell-surface receptor activated by adrenaline (epinephrine), noradrenaline (norepinephrine), or related medicines. Alpha and beta receptors help control heart rate, blood pressure, airway size, pupil size, and other body responses.

Adrenergic Receptors

Plural form; see *Adrenergic Receptor*.

Adrenocortical Carcinoma

A rare cancer that begins in the outer layer, or cortex, of an adrenal gland, one of the glands above the kidneys. Some tumors are functioning and make too much of hormones such as cortisol, aldosterone, or adrenal androgens; others are nonfunctioning and make no excess hormones. Hormone-producing tumors may cause weight gain, high blood pressure, muscle weakness, unusual hair growth, or other changes in sexual development. A nonfunctioning tumor may cause no early symptoms, but a growing or spreading tumor may cause an abdominal lump, abdominal or back pain, or a feeling of fullness.

Adrenocorticotropic Hormone

A hormone made by the pituitary gland that tells the adrenal glands to make cortisol. Cortisol helps the body respond to stress and helps control blood pressure, blood sugar, and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Adrenocorticotrophic Hormone (ACTH); ACTH; Corticotropin

Adrenogenital Syndrome

A group of disorders, usually caused by congenital adrenal hyperplasia, in which excess adrenal androgens cause atypical genital development or early puberty.

Adrenoleukodystrophy

A group of inherited disorders, most often X-linked, in which very-long-chain fatty acids accumulate and damage myelin, the adrenal glands, or both. Childhood cerebral disease can cause behavior and learning changes, seizures, and loss of neurologic function; adrenal insufficiency may also occur.

Alternate Names:
ALD

Adrenomedullin

A hormone-like substance made by many tissues that widens blood vessels and helps regulate blood pressure, circulation, fluid balance, kidney activity, and responses to injury.

Adrenomyeloneuropathy

An adult-onset form of X-linked adrenoleukodystrophy that mainly affects the spinal cord and peripheral nerves. It may cause leg stiffness, weakness, walking difficulty, bladder or bowel problems, and sometimes adrenal insufficiency.

Adson Test

A physical examination manoeuvre sometimes used when assessing possible thoracic outlet syndrome. A change in the radial pulse or symptoms during the manoeuvre is not specific and cannot diagnose the condition by itself.

Alternate Names:
Adson Manoeuvre; Adson's Test

Adsorption

The sticking of molecules to the outside surface of a solid or liquid rather than entering its substance. Activated charcoal works partly by adsorbing some poisons in the digestive tract.

Adult Congenital Heart Disease

Structural cardiac abnormalities present from birth that persist into or are first identified during adult life, including repaired, palliated, or unrepaired defects such as bicuspid aortic valve, atrial or ventricular septal defects, and coarctation of the aorta.

Alternate Names:
ACHD; Congenital Heart Disease in Adults

Adult Day Services

Community-based daytime programs providing supervision, social activities, health-related support, or assistance with daily activities for adults who cannot safely remain alone throughout the day.

Alternate Names:
Adult Day Care; Adult Day Program

Adult Hypertension

Blood pressure that stays above the diagnostic threshold used by a clinical guideline. Thresholds vary between guidelines and measurement settings. Persistent high blood pressure increases the risk of heart, brain, and kidney disease.

Alternate Names:
Systemic Hypertension

Adult Immunisation

Vaccination of adults to prevent infectious diseases, maintain protection from earlier vaccines, or protect people at increased risk. Vaccine schedules vary by country, age, health conditions, occupation, pregnancy, and previous vaccination history.

Alternate Names:
Adult Immunization; Adult Vaccination; Preventive Adult Vaccines

Adult Informed Consent

A process in which an adult with decision-making capacity receives understandable information about a proposed medical intervention, including its purpose, benefits, important risks, and alternatives, and makes a voluntary choice.

Alternate Names:
Informed Medical Consent; Surgical Consent; Patient Autonomous Decision-Making

Adult Nutritional Support in Illness

Dietary strategies providing increased caloric and protein intake during acute or chronic illness, convalescence, or hypermetabolic states to prevent involuntary weight loss and muscle wasting.

Alternate Names:
High-Calorie Diet in Illness; Nutritional Therapy in Recovery

Adult Obstructive Sleep Apnea

Repeated narrowing or closure of the upper airway during sleep in an adult, causing pauses or reductions in breathing and sometimes drops in blood

oxygen. It can fragment sleep, cause daytime sleepiness, and increase cardiovascular risk.

Alternate Names:
Adult OSA; Obstructive Sleep Apnea Syndrome

Adult-Onset Asthma

Asthma that begins in adulthood, with variable airway inflammation and narrowing that can cause episodic wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or shortness of breath. Diagnosis uses the symptom pattern and lung-function testing.

Alternate Names:
Late-Onset Asthma; Adult-Onset Reactive Airway Disease

Adult-Onset Still Disease

A rare inflammatory disease that causes recurring high fevers, joint pain or swelling, a salmon-colored rash, and sore throat. It may also inflame the liver, heart, lungs, or other organs.

Adult-Onset Still's Disease

Alternate name; see *Adult-Onset Still Disease*.

Alternate Names:
AOSD; Still's Disease in Adults

Adult Primary Brain Tumor

A tumour that begins in the brain, its coverings, or related structures in an adult rather than spreading there from another site. Types include gliomas, meningiomas, vestibular schwannomas, and primary central nervous system lymphomas.

Alternate Names:
Primary Intracranial Neoplasm

Adult Spinal Deformity

Abnormal curvature or alignment of the spine in an adult, including scoliosis, kyphosis, or loss of normal sagittal balance. It may cause back pain, nerve compression, difficulty walking, or functional disability.

Adult T-Cell Leukemia

A rare and aggressive peripheral T-cell neoplasm caused by infection with the human T-lymphotropic virus type 1 (HTLV-1). Characterized by generalized lymphadenopathy, hepatosplenomegaly, osteolytic bone lesions, severe hypercalcemia, skin infiltration, and atypical multi-lobed circulating lymphocytes known as flower cells.

Alternate Names:
Adult T-Cell Leukemia-Lymphoma; ATLL

Advance Care Planning

A process for discussing and preparing for future health-care decisions, especially if illness may later limit a person's ability to decide or communicate. It may involve the person, loved ones, and clinicians and can result in written instructions or appointment of a health-care proxy. It is broader than an advance directive, which is a legal document recording some preferences.

Advanced Cancer

Cancer that has grown beyond its original site. It may be locally advanced when it has invaded nearby tissues or metastatic when it has spread to distant organs.

Advanced Cardiovascular Life Support

A standardized set of advanced resuscitation measures for cardiac arrest and other life-threatening cardiovascular emergencies. It includes high-quality CPR, defibrillation when indicated, airway management, medicines, and treatment of reversible causes.

Alternate Names:
ACLS

Advanced Glycation End-Products

Compounds formed when sugar attaches to proteins or fats without the usual enzyme-controlled process. They increase with aging and persistently high blood sugar and may promote inflammation and damage to blood vessels, nerves, kidneys, and other tissues.

Advance Directive

A document recording a person's wishes about future medical care and, in some cases, naming a health-care proxy to make decisions if the person cannot decide or communicate. Its legal form and requirements vary by jurisdiction.

Alternate Names:
Advance Health-Care Directive; Advance Medical Directive

Advanced Maternal Age

A clinical obstetric term for pregnancy in a person who will be 35 years or older at the estimated date of delivery. The chance of some chromosomal conditions and obstetric complications rises with age, but individual risk varies and age alone does not determine pregnancy outcome.

Alternate Names:
AMA Pregnancy

Advanced Prostate Cancer

Prostate cancer that has grown beyond the prostate or spread to distant parts of the body. It may involve nearby tissues, lymph nodes, bones, or other organs.

Advanced Sleep-Wake Phase Disorder

A body-clock disorder in which a person becomes sleepy much earlier than desired and wakes unusually early. The person may sleep normally on this early schedule but cannot stay asleep until a more convenient time.

Advance Statements

Statements, spoken or written, describing a person's preferences for future health care. Their legal status and scope vary by jurisdiction; some are part of an advance directive.

Adventitia

The outer layer of connective tissue around a blood vessel or hollow organ. It supports and anchors the structure and contains small nerves and blood vessels that nourish the wall.

Alternate Names:
Tunica Adventitia

Adventitial Cystic Disease

A rare, non-atherosclerotic vascular condition characterized by the formation of mucin-filled cysts within the adventitial layer of an artery, most frequently the popliteal artery, resulting in extrinsic arterial compression and intermittent claudication.

Alternate Names:
Cystic Adventitial Disease

Adventitious

Abnormal, unexpected, or arising from an unusual location or process; adventitious lung sounds include crackles, wheezes, and other added breath sounds.

Adverse Effect

An unintended and harmful or bothersome effect of a medicine or other treatment given at normal doses or for an intended purpose.

Adverse Event

Any new or worsening health problem that happens during or after a medicine, procedure, or other treatment, whether or not the treatment caused it. Clinicians record its timing, severity, and likely cause separately.

Adverse Reaction

An unintended and harmful response to a medicine, treatment, or other exposure. It may be predictable from the medicine's effects, such as bleeding with an anticoagulant, or unpredictable, such as an allergic reaction. Severity ranges from mild nausea or rash to serious organ injury, breathing difficulty, or shock.

Alternate Names:
Adverse Drug Reaction

Aedes Aegypti

Aedes aegypti is a mosquito that can transmit dengue, yellow fever, chikungunya, Zika, and other viruses.

Aegophony

An altered voice sound heard through a stethoscope when a person says "E" but it sounds like "A." It can occur over lung tissue made denser by infection or fluid, but it does not identify the cause by itself.

A & E Medicine

Accident and emergency (A&E) medicine provides

rapid assessment, stabilization, diagnosis, and initial treatment for sudden illness and injury.

Aerobe

An organism that uses oxygen in its metabolism. Obligate aerobes require oxygen for growth, while facultative anaerobes can grow with or without it; these categories describe different oxygen requirements.

Aerobic

Requiring or using oxygen. In microbiology, an aerobic organism grows with oxygen; in the body, aerobic energy production uses oxygen to release energy from nutrients for muscles and other cells.

Aerobic Bacteria

Bacteria that grow using oxygen in their metabolism. Obligate aerobes require oxygen, whereas facultative anaerobes can also grow without it; laboratory classification depends on the species' oxygen requirements.

Aerobic Bacterium

Singular form; see *Aerobic Bacteria*.

Aerobic Exercise

Physical activity using large muscles continuously while the body produces energy with oxygen. Walking, cycling, swimming, and dancing can improve heart, lung, blood-vessel, muscle, mood, and endurance health.

Alternate Names:
Cardio Exercise

Aerobiosis

Life or biological activity that occurs when oxygen is available. Many human cells use oxygen to release energy from food, and some microorganisms need oxygen to grow.

Aerophagia

Excessive swallowing of air, which may cause frequent belching, abdominal bloating, discomfort, or increased intestinal gas. It can occur with rapid eating, chewing gum, anxiety, or swallowing disorders.

Aerophagy

Alternate spelling; see *Aerophagia*.

Aerophobia

An excessive fear of flying or air travel that causes marked anxiety, avoidance, or interference with daily life. It is a specific phobia.

Aerosol

Very small solid particles or liquid drops floating in a gas such as air. Aerosols can carry inhaled medicines, pollutants, or infectious particles and may remain in the air or settle on surfaces.

Aerospace Medicine

The medical field that protects the health, safety, and performance of people involved in aviation and spaceflight, including crews and passengers. It combines clinical, preventive, occupational, and environmental medicine with flight physiology, addressing stresses such as hypoxia, pressure change, acceleration, microgravity, radiation, isolation, and motion sickness.

Aerotitis

Ear pain or middle-ear injury caused by failure to equalize pressure during rapid changes in altitude, such as during aircraft ascent or descent.

Aesthetic Dentistry

Dental care intended to improve the appearance of the teeth, gums, or smile. Procedures may include tooth-colored restorations, veneers, whitening, or selected crowns.

Aesthetic Medicine

Medical care intended to improve appearance or reduce visible signs of aging through procedures, devices, medicines, or skin care; appropriate assessment includes risks, contraindications, and realistic expectations.

Alternate Names:
Cosmetic Medicine

Aetiology

The cause or causes of a disease or condition; also, the study of those causes. Causes may include genetic, environmental, infectious, or immune factors.

Alternate Names:
Etiology

Affect

The observable expression of a person's emotional state, including facial expression, voice, posture, and emotional responsiveness.

Affective Disorder

Another name for a mood disorder, a group of mental health conditions involving lasting changes in mood. These include depression, bipolar disorder, and related conditions. Older medical systems called the group "mood [affective] disorders"; ICD-11 calls it "mood disorders."

Alternate Names:
Mood Disorder

Affective Flattening

Markedly reduced outward expression of emotion, including limited facial expression, voice modulation, and gestures. It may occur in schizophrenia and other psychiatric or neurologic conditions.

Afferent

Carrying signals toward a central organ or structure; afferent nerves transmit sensory information from the body toward the brain and spinal cord.

Afferent Arteriole

A small branch of the renal arterial circulation that conveys blood directly into the glomerular capillary tuft of an individual nephron, playing a pivotal role in regulating glomerular filtration pressure and renal blood flow through autoregulatory and tubuloglomerular mechanisms.

Afferent Loop Syndrome

A blockage or poor emptying in a section of small intestine made during some stomach operations. Digestive juices build up behind the blockage, causing upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, or poor absorption of nutrients.

Afferent Lymphatic Vessel

A lymphatic vessel that carries lymph into a lymph node.

Afferent Neuron

A sensory nerve cell carrying signals from receptors in the body toward the spinal cord and brain, where information is processed and appropriate responses begin.

Afferent Pathway

A sensory nerve route carrying information from the skin, muscles, organs, or other tissues toward the spinal cord or brain, where the signals are processed and responses can begin.

Alternate Names:
Sensory Pathway

Afferent Pupillary Defect

An asymmetry in pupillary light reactivity caused by a unilateral or asymmetric lesion in the anterior visual afferent pathway (optic nerve or retina). Identified during the swinging-flashlight test when swinging the light beam from the unaffected eye to the affected eye results in paradoxical bilateral pupillary dilation rather than constriction.

Alternate Names:
Relative Afferent Pupillary Defect; RAPD

Affinity

The strength of attraction or binding between two molecules, such as an antibody and antigen, receptor and ligand, or enzyme and substrate.

Affinity Chromatography

A laboratory method for separating and purifying a substance by allowing it to stick to a partner designed to recognize it. Other substances are washed away, and the desired substance is then released.

A Fib

Alternate name; see *Atrial Fibrillation*.

AFib

Alternate name; see *Atrial Fibrillation*.

Afibrinogenaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Afibrinogenemia*.

Afibrinogenemia

A rare congenital or severe acquired coagulation disorder characterized by the complete or near-complete absence of circulating fibrinogen (factor I, <0.1 g/L). Inherited in an autosomal recessive pattern (mutations in *FGA*, *FGB*, or *FGG*), it manifests with umbilical cord bleeding in neonates, spontaneous mucosal and intracranial hemorrhages, hemarthroses, and prolonged bleeding times.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Afibrinogenemia; Fibrinogen Deficiency; Afibrinogenaemia

Aflatoxin

A toxin made by certain molds that can contaminate foods such as grains, nuts, and spices. Long-term exposure can damage the liver and increase the risk of liver cancer.

African Sleeping Sickness

Alternate name; see *Human African Trypanosomiasis*.

African Trypanosomiasis

Alternate name; see *Human African Trypanosomiasis*.

Afterbirth

The placenta and the membranes that surrounded the baby, which leave the womb after childbirth. If any part remains inside, it can cause heavy bleeding or infection.

After-Cataract

Clouding of the thin membrane behind the artificial lens after cataract surgery. It can develop months or years later and cause blurred or hazy vision, glare around lights, or reduced sharpness of vision.

Alternate Names:
Posterior Capsule Opacification; Secondary Cataract

Afterdepolarization

An abnormal electrical oscillation occurring during or immediately following myocardial action potential repolarization, capable of reaching threshold and triggering cardiac arrhythmias. Early afterdepolarizations occur during plateau or repolarization phases, while delayed afterdepolarizations occur after repolarization is complete.

Afterload

The pressure or resistance the heart must overcome to push blood out of its ventricles. Higher blood pressure or narrowing of blood vessels increases the heart's workload and can make pumping less efficient.

Afterpains

Cramp-like pains in the lower abdomen during the first few days after childbirth, caused by the womb tightening and shrinking. They may become stronger during breastfeeding and help reduce bleeding.

Aftershave Poisoning

Harm from swallowing aftershave, which may contain alcohol, fragrance, or other chemicals. It can cause vomiting, drowsiness, low blood sugar, breathing problems, or coma.

Against-the-rule Astigmatism

A type of astigmatism in which the steepest curve is close to horizontal rather than vertical. This uneven curve makes light focus unevenly on the retina, which can blur or distort vision. It is the opposite of with-the-rule astigmatism.

Agammaglobulinaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Agammaglobulinemia*.

Agammaglobulinemia

A serious immune deficiency with very low or absent immunoglobulins, usually caused by impaired

development of antibody-producing B cells. It leads to recurrent bacterial infections, especially of the ears, sinuses, lungs, or bloodstream.

Aganglionic Megacolon

Congenital absence of nerve cells in part of the large intestine, causing Hirschsprung disease. The affected segment cannot relax normally, leading to intestinal obstruction, abdominal swelling, and delayed passage of stool.

Agar

A jelly-like substance made from red seaweed. Laboratories add it to nutrient mixtures to grow and identify bacteria and fungi on solid surfaces, such as culture plates. It is also used in some bulk laxatives.

Agatston Score

A number calculated from a special CT scan that measures calcium in the heart's arteries. A higher score usually means more coronary plaque and higher heart-disease risk, but it does not directly show blockage. Doctors interpret it with age, sex, blood pressure, cholesterol, diabetes, smoking, family history, and other health conditions.

Alternate Names:
Coronary Artery Calcium (CAC) Score; Agatston Calcium Score

Ageing

Ageing is the natural, lifelong process of physical and biological change. Over time, body reserves may decrease and the risk of some diseases may increase, but the effects vary between people.

Alternate Names:
Aging

Agenesis

Failure of an organ or body structure to form before birth, so it is absent. Agenesis may affect one organ, such as a kidney, or a specific body structure, such as the corpus callosum.

Agenesis of Commissura Magna Cerebri

An older anatomic name for agenesis of the corpus callosum, in which the major commissural fiber tract connecting the cerebral hemispheres is absent or underdeveloped.

Agenesis Of The Corpus Callosum

A birth condition in which the band of nerve fibres connecting the brain's two halves is partly or completely absent. Effects vary widely and may include seizures, developmental delay, learning difficulties, or no noticeable symptoms.

Age Regression

A mental state or behavior involving a temporary return to thoughts, feelings, behaviors, or mannerisms associated with an earlier stage of life. It may occur in dissociative disorders, hypnosis, trauma-related states, or some therapeutic contexts and is not itself a diagnosis.

Age-Related Cataract

Clouding of the eye's natural lens that develops with aging as lens proteins and structure change. It is the most common type of cataract and often progresses gradually, causing blurred or faded vision, glare, reduced contrast, or difficulty seeing at night.

Age-Related Hearing Loss

Alternate name; see *Presbycusis*.

Age-Related Macular Degeneration

A degenerative disease of the macula associated with aging that can impair detailed central vision. Dry (atrophic) disease involves gradual loss of retinal cells; wet (neovascular) disease involves abnormal blood vessels that leak or bleed beneath or within the retina and may cause faster vision loss.

Alternate Names:
AMD

Age Spots

Flat tan, brown, or black spots on chronically sun-exposed skin, especially the face and backs of the hands. Also called solar lentigines, they result from localized accumulation of melanin and are benign; they are unrelated to liver disease.

Alternate Names:
Liver Spots; Solar Lentigines; Senile Lentigines; Sun Spots

Age-Standardized Rate

A disease or death rate recalculated as if different populations had the same age distribution. This makes comparisons fairer when one population has more older or younger people than another.

Ageusia

Complete loss of the ability to taste. It may result from infections, mouth or nose problems, medicines, chemotherapy, head injury, nerve damage, nutritional deficiency, or neurological disease. Loss of smell can also make food seem tasteless.

Agger Nasi

The most anterior and superior ethmoidal air cell, located immediately anterior to the attachment of the middle nasal turbinate and serving as an important anatomical landmark in functional endoscopic sinus surgery.

Agglutination

Visible clumping that occurs when antibodies or other binding substances join cells or particles together. Laboratory workers use this reaction to help identify blood groups, infections, and other substances in patient samples.

Agglutination Test

A laboratory test that mixes a patient sample with a known antibody or antigen. Visible clumping suggests that the matching substance is present and may help identify blood groups or infections.

Agglutinin

An antibody or other substance that causes cells or particles to stick together in visible clumps. Agglutinins are used in laboratory tests, including blood-group testing and some infection tests.

Agglutinogen

An antigen on a cell or particle that can react with a matching antibody and cause visible clumping. Agglutinogens are especially important in identifying blood groups.

Aggression

Words or actions intended to threaten, harm, or intimidate another person or damage property. Aggression may result from emotional distress, pain, mental illness, brain disorders, medicines, or substance use.

Aggressive

Describes behavior that is forceful or hostile, or a disease that progresses rapidly, invades nearby tissue, or spreads. When used for a disease, the word is a general description and does not by itself specify its growth rate or prognosis.

Aggressive Angiomyxoma

A rare, usually slow-growing soft-tissue tumor that most often develops in the vulva, perineum, or pelvis of women of reproductive age. It can grow into nearby tissue and often returns after treatment, but rarely spreads to distant organs.

Aggressive Cancer

A cancer that is likely to grow, invade nearby tissue, or spread quickly. Doctors assess its aggressiveness using the cancer type, cell appearance, genetic features, stage, growth rate, and response to treatment.

Agility

The ability to move, stop, or change direction quickly while staying balanced and controlled. Doctors and therapists may assess agility when evaluating movement, coordination, recovery from injury, or physical function.

Agitation

An uncomfortable state of inner tension, restlessness, or increased activity. It may cause pacing, irritability, or inability to remain calm and can result from medical illness, pain, medicines, substance use, or mental health conditions.

Agnathia

A rare birth condition in which the lower jaw is partly or completely absent. It may cause major facial abnormalities and serious problems with breathing, swallowing, and feeding.

Agnogenic Myeloid Metaplasia (AMM)

An older name for primary myelofibrosis, a chronic bone-marrow disorder in which abnormal scar tissue and blood-cell production outside the marrow cause anemia, enlarged spleen, constitutional symptoms, and abnormal blood counts.

Agnosia

An inability to recognize familiar objects, people, sounds, or other sensations even though the related sense works normally. It usually results from damage to areas of the brain that interpret sensory information.

Agonist

A drug or other ligand that binds to a receptor and activates it, producing a biological response. A full agonist can produce the maximum response in a given system, whereas a partial agonist produces a submaximal response even when occupying receptors.

Agonist Muscle

The main muscle responsible for producing a particular movement.

Alternate Names:
Prime Mover

Agoraphobia

An anxiety disorder involving persistent, intense fear of places or situations where escape may be difficult, help may be unavailable, or panic-like symptoms may feel embarrassing. People may avoid crowds, public transportation, shops, or leaving home alone; the fear and avoidance cause significant distress or interfere with daily functioning.

Agostini's Reaction

A historical chemical test for glucose in urine. It used a gold-chloride reagent and an alkali; when heated with glucose, the mixture turned red. It is not a routine test in modern clinical practice.

Alternate Names:
Agostini's Test

Agranulocytes

A group of white blood cells that do not have prominent granules when viewed under a microscope. The group mainly includes lymphocytes and monocytes, which help defend the body against infection.

Agranulocytosis

A serious condition with a profoundly low number of granulocytes, especially neutrophils; it is often defined by an absolute neutrophil count below 500 cells per microliter, although thresholds vary. It increases the risk of severe infection and may result from medicines, chemotherapy, infection, autoimmune disease, or bone-marrow disorders.

Agraphesthesia

An inability to recognize a number or letter traced on the skin with the eyes closed, despite normal basic touch sensation. It may indicate damage to the opposite parietal lobe of the brain.

Agraphia

Loss of a previously learned ability to write because of brain damage or disease. It may follow a stroke, head injury, brain tumour, or neurodegenerative disease and may occur with problems speaking or reading.

Aicardi-Goutieres Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which abnormal immune activity causes inflammation and damage mainly in the brain, skin, and immune system. It may begin in infancy with developmental regression, seizures, brain changes, and painful skin lesions.

Aicardi Syndrome

A rare neurodevelopmental disorder affecting mainly girls, classically involving infantile spasms, partial or complete absence of the corpus callosum, and distinctive chorioretinal lacunae. Other brain, eye,

and skeletal abnormalities may occur, and severity varies.

Aichmophobia

An intense, irrational, and persistent fear of sharp or pointed objects, such as needles, knives, scissors, or pens, producing acute situational anxiety or avoidance behavior.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Sharp Objects

AIDS

The most advanced stage of HIV infection. In the United States, AIDS is diagnosed when a person with HIV has a CD4 count below 200 cells/mm^3 or develops an AIDS-defining condition.

Alternate Names:
Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome; Stage 3 HIV Infection

AIDS-Associated Nephropathy

Kidney disease caused by HIV, usually in untreated or poorly controlled infection. It often causes large amounts of protein in the urine and may rapidly worsen kidney function, leading to kidney failure.

Alternate Names:
HIV-Associated Nephropathy

AIDS-Defining Illnesses

Infections and cancers classified as AIDS-defining conditions in a person with HIV. Their presence can meet the clinical criteria for AIDS, even when a current CD4 count is unavailable. Examples include Pneumocystis pneumonia, Kaposi sarcoma, cytomegalovirus retinitis, and esophageal candidiasis.

Alternate Names:
AIDS-Defining Conditions; AIDS-Defining Opportunistic Infections

AIDS Dementia

A severe form of HIV-associated brain disease occurring mainly in advanced HIV infection. It may cause worsening memory and thinking, slowed movement, difficulty walking, and changes in behaviour.

Ailurophobia

An excessive, irrational fear of cats, leading to significant distress, anxiety symptoms, or behavioral avoidance of domestic felines.

Alternate Names:
Gatophobia; Fear of Cats

Ainhum

A rare disorder in which a painful fibrous band slowly tightens around a toe, usually the little toe. The band can damage bone and blood supply and may eventually cause loss of the affected part.

Alternate Names:
Dactylolysis Spontanea

Air Abrasion

A dental technique that uses compressed air to spray fine abrasive particles onto a tooth. It can remove limited decay, stains, or old filling material and prepare the tooth for a restoration.

Air Bag

An inflatable vehicle safety device that rapidly expands during a crash to cushion impact and reduce serious injury. It works with, but does not replace, a properly worn seat belt.

Airborne Disease

An infection that can spread when a person breathes in tiny particles containing germs that remain in the air. The risk depends on the germ, ventilation, distance, and length of exposure.

Airborne Precautions

Infection-control measures for pathogens that can spread through infectious particles suspended in air. They include placement in an airborne infection isolation room with negative pressure and appropriate ventilation, limiting transport, and use of a fit-tested respirator such as an N95. They are used for infections such as tuberculosis, measles, and chickenpox.

Air Bronchogram

A branching pattern of air-filled airways seen within

an area of lung that has lost its normal air, usually because the air sacs contain fluid, pus, blood, or cells. It is a sign on a chest X-ray or CT scan.

Air-Conditioner Lung

A form of hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhaling microbial antigens from contaminated air-conditioning or humidifying systems. It can cause recurrent fever, cough, shortness of breath, and diffuse lung inflammation; prolonged or repeated exposure may lead to chronic lung damage.

Air Contaminants

Harmful substances in indoor or outdoor air, including smoke, dust, gases, chemicals, allergens, and germs. Health effects depend on the substance, amount breathed, duration of exposure, and a person's health.

Air Embolism

A blockage of blood flow caused by an air or gas bubble entering the bloodstream. Air can enter the circulation during surgical or medical procedures, chest trauma, or rapid pressure changes (such as ascending too quickly during scuba diving). Depending on where the bubble travels, it can block blood flow to the lungs, heart, or brain, potentially causing severe shortness of breath, chest pain, stroke-like symptoms, or loss of consciousness.

Alternate Names:
Gas Embolism; Vascular Air Embolism

Air Passages

The connected tubes that carry air from the nose and mouth to the lungs. They include the throat, voice box, windpipe, and branching airways; swelling, mucus, or an object can narrow or block them.

Airplane Ear

Ear pain, fullness, popping, or temporary hearing loss caused by unequal air pressure on the two sides of the eardrum during takeoff or landing. It is more likely with a blocked nose or ear infection.

Alternate Names:
Barotitis Media

Air Polishing

A dental procedure that directs air, water, and a fine powder onto teeth to remove plaque and surface stains. Common powders include glycine, erythritol, and sodium bicarbonate.

Air Pollution

Air contaminated with harmful gases, particles, smoke, chemicals, or germs. Breathing polluted air can irritate the eyes and lungs and increase the risk of asthma attacks, infections, heart disease, stroke, and other health problems.

Air Quality

A measure of how clean or polluted the air is, based on the amounts of harmful substances it contains. Poor air quality can affect breathing and heart health, especially in people with existing medical conditions.

Air Sac

A thin-walled structure that contains air. In human lungs, individual air sacs are alveoli, where oxygen enters the blood and carbon dioxide leaves it. Birds have larger air sacs that help move air through their lungs, but those sacs do not themselves carry out gas exchange.

Air-Sickness

Motion sickness caused by the movement of an aircraft. Mismatched signals from the eyes and inner ear can cause nausea, dizziness, sweating, headache, and sometimes vomiting.

Airsickness

Alternate spelling; see *Air-Sickness*.

Air Trapping

A condition in which extra air remains in the lungs after breathing out because narrowed or damaged airways prevent complete exhalation. It commonly occurs in asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, and bronchiolitis.

Airway

Any passage that carries air between the outside of the body and the lungs, including the nose, mouth, throat, voice box, windpipe, and branching tubes. Swelling, mucus, or an object can narrow or block an airway and restrict breathing.

Airway Clearance Techniques

Methods used to loosen and remove mucus from the breathing tubes. They include controlled coughing, breathing exercises, drainage positions, devices that create resistance during exhalation, and vibrating vests. The choice depends on the illness and the person's strength and ability.

Airway Management

The methods and equipment used to keep a person's airway open and support breathing when airflow is threatened. They may include positioning, suction, airway devices, or a breathing tube connected to a ventilator.

Airway Obstruction

A blockage that partly or fully stops air from moving through the breathing passages. It may be caused by food or another object entering the airway, swelling, mucus, injury, a tumor, or relaxed airway muscles. It can cause noisy breathing, wheezing, low blood oxygen, or breathing to stop.

Airway Resistance

The difficulty air encounters while moving through the breathing tubes. Narrowing from muscle tightening, swelling, mucus, or loss of support increases resistance and makes the breathing muscles work harder.

Akathisia

A movement disorder causing an uncomfortable inner restlessness and a strong urge to move, often with pacing, rocking, or repeated shifting of the legs. It is commonly a side effect of antipsychotic or other medicines.

Akinesia

An inability to initiate or perform voluntary movement, or a marked lack of spontaneous movement. It may occur in Parkinson disease and related disorders, severe depression, or other conditions affecting the brain's movement-control systems.

Akinetic

Describing a person or condition with little or no voluntary movement. It may result from a neurological disease, medicine effect, severe illness, or damage to the brain's movement-control systems.

Akinetic Mutism

A state in which a person is awake but makes little or no voluntary movement or speech. It usually results from severe damage or dysfunction in brain areas that control motivation, attention, and movement.

Akinetopsia

A rare neuropsychological visual deficit characterized by an inability to perceive visual motion, resulting in moving objects appearing as a succession of static freeze-frames. It typically results from bilateral cortical lesions in the middle temporal visual area (area MT/V5).

Alternate Names:
Motion Blindness; Visual Motion Agnosia

Alagille Syndrome

A genetic disorder in which too few or abnormal bile ducts can cause liver disease and jaundice. It may also affect the heart, kidneys, eyes, blood vessels, bones, and facial features. Most cases involve changes in the JAG1 gene.

AL Amyloidosis

A disorder in which clonal plasma cells produce immunoglobulin light chains that misfold and form extracellular amyloid fibrils in tissues. Deposits can impair the heart, kidneys, peripheral nerves, liver, or digestive tract. It is distinct from transthyretin and serum amyloid A amyloidosis.

Alternate Names:
Light Chain Amyloidosis

Alanine

An amino acid, or protein-building molecule, made by the body and obtained from food. Cells use it to make proteins and to help move nitrogen and produce glucose for energy.

Alanine Aminotransferase

An enzyme found mainly inside liver cells. When liver cells are injured, alanine aminotransferase can leak into the blood, causing a raised test result. The result helps assess liver injury but does not identify its cause by itself.

Alternate Names:
ALT

Alanine Aminotransferase Test

A blood test that measures the level of alanine aminotransferase, an enzyme concentrated in liver cells; elevated levels typically indicate acute or chronic liver inflammation or injury. See *Alanine Aminotransferase* and *Liver Function Tests*.

Alanine Transaminase Blood Test

A blood test that measures alanine aminotransferase, an enzyme released when liver cells are damaged. A high result may occur with hepatitis, medicine-related injury, fatty liver disease, or other conditions; its significance varies with clinical context.

ALARA Principle

A foundational radiation safety standard mandating that occupational and medical ionizing radiation exposures be kept as low as reasonably achievable, utilizing dose optimization, exposure time reduction, increased distance, and protective shielding.

Alternate Names:
As Low As Reasonably Achievable

Alarmin

A signal released by injured or severely stressed cells that alerts the immune system. It helps start inflammation and attract protective cells to damaged tissue, even before the body identifies whether infection is present.

Albendazole

An antiparasitic medicine that damages the internal structures parasites need to absorb nutrients and survive. It treats several worm infections, including some intestinal and tissue infections, when prescribed for the appropriate parasite.

Albers-SchöNberg Disease

A usually inherited form of osteopetrosis in which bones become unusually dense because old bone is not removed normally. The bones can still break easily and may cause pain or pressure on nerves, especially in the skull.

Alternate Names:
Autosomal Dominant Osteopetrosis Type II (ADO II); Marble Bone Disease

Albinism

A group of inherited genetic conditions in which the body produces little or no melanin, the pigment responsible for skin, hair, and eye coloration. Characterized by pale skin, white or light blond hair, and light-colored irises, it frequently causes visual impairments—including reduced visual sharpness, rapid involuntary eye movements (nystagmus), extreme sensitivity to bright light (photophobia), and abnormal optic nerve development. People with albinism have an elevated risk of severe sunburn and skin cancer, requiring strict sun protection.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Achromia

Albinismus

Alternate Latin term; see *Albinism*.

Albino

An older noun for a person or animal with albinism, an inherited condition involving reduced melanin. For people, “person with albinism” is usually preferred because it describes the condition without defining the person by it.

Albright Hereditary Osteodystrophy

A genetic condition that may cause short stature, a round face, obesity, dental problems, extra bone under the skin, and shortening of some finger bones.

It is linked to changes in the *GNAS* gene and may occur with hormone-resistance disorders.

Alternate Names:
AHO

Albright's Hereditary Osteodystrophy

A group of inherited features that may include short stature, a round face, shortened fingers or toes, extra bone under the skin, and obesity. Some people also have resistance to parathyroid hormone or other hormones.

Albumen

The white part of an egg, made mostly of water and proteins. Albumen is a food substance and is different from albumin, the main protein in blood plasma.

Albumin

The main protein in blood plasma, made by the liver. It helps keep fluid inside blood vessels and carries substances such as hormones, fatty acids, and some medicines through the bloodstream.

Alternate Names:
Serum Albumin

Albumin Clearance

A measure of how quickly the blood protein albumin leaves the bloodstream or another body space. It is used mainly in specialized kidney, liver, or research tests to study leakage, transport, or removal of the protein.

Albuminocytologic Dissociation

A characteristic cerebrospinal fluid finding marked by an elevated protein concentration in the absence of a commensurate increase in white blood cell count. Classically seen in Guillain-Barr'e syndrome after the first week of illness, as well as in chronic inflammatory demyelinating polyneuropathy and spinal cord tumors.

Alternate Names:
Albumino-Cytological Dissociation; Protein-Cell Dissociation

Albumin Test

A blood or urine test measuring the concentration of albumin, the predominant circulating protein produced by the liver, used to assess nutritional status, liver synthetic function, and kidney disease; see *Albumin*.

Albumin-To-Creatinine Ratio

A urine test that estimates how much albumin, a blood protein, is leaking through the kidneys by comparing it with creatinine in the same sample. A persistent result above 30 mg/g may indicate kidney damage; results above 300 mg/g indicate severe leakage.

Albuminuria

An abnormally high amount of albumin in the urine, showing that the kidneys are allowing this blood protein to pass through. It may be temporary or persistent; ongoing albuminuria can indicate kidney damage and increased cardiovascular risk.

ALCAPA Syndrome

A rare congenital cardiovascular anomaly in which the left coronary artery arises abnormally from the pulmonary artery instead of the aorta. Because the pulmonary artery carries desaturated blood at low pressure, myocardial perfusion is compromised, leading to retrograde coronary flow (coronary steal), infantile heart failure, myocardial infarction, and mitral regurgitation if uncorrected.

Alternate Names:
ALCAPA; Bland-White-Garland Syndrome; Anomalous Left Coronary Artery from the Pulmonary Artery

Alcohol

Ethanol, a substance in beer, wine, and spirits that affects the central nervous system. Excessive consumption impairs motor coordination and cognitive judgment, produces acute intoxication, and can lead to physical dependence, metabolic toxicity, and chronic organ damage.

Alcohol-Associated Liver Disease

Liver injury associated with alcohol use. It ranges

from steatosis and inflammation to fibrosis, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer; severity depends on alcohol exposure, genetics, nutrition, and other health factors.

Alcohol Dehydrogenase

An enzyme found mainly in the liver that begins breaking down alcohol. It changes alcohol into acetaldehyde, a harmful intermediate that is then processed into less toxic substances.

Alternate Names:
ADH; Ethanol Dehydrogenase

Alcoholic Cardiomyopathy

Alternate name; see *Alcohol-Induced Cardiomyopathy*.

Alcoholic Foetor

An alcohol-like odor on the breath after recent alcohol consumption. Breath odor alone cannot determine the amount consumed or establish intoxication.

Alternate Names:
Alcoholic Fetor; Alcohol Breath; Fetor Alcoholicus

Alcoholic Hepatitis

An acute inflammation and injury of the liver caused by heavy alcohol use. It commonly causes jaundice, fatigue, fever, nausea, and abdominal pain and can become severe enough to cause liver failure.

Alternate Names:
Alcohol-Associated Hepatitis; Alcohol-Induced Hepatitis

Alcoholic Ketoacidosis

A dangerous buildup of acids in the blood that can occur after prolonged heavy alcohol use, poor food intake, and repeated vomiting. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea, dehydration, rapid breathing, and a normal or low blood-sugar level.

Alcoholic Liver Disease

Alternate name; see *Alcohol-Associated Liver Disease*.

Alcoholic Myopathy

Muscle damage caused by heavy alcohol use. It may cause muscle pain, tenderness, weakness, or wasting; severe acute injury can destroy muscle tissue and damage the kidneys.

Alternate Names:
Alcohol-Induced Myopathy; Ethanol-Induced Myopathy

Alcoholic Neuropathy

Peripheral nerve damage associated with long-term heavy alcohol use and sometimes nutritional deficiency. It commonly causes burning pain, numbness, tingling, or weakness, especially in the feet and lower legs.

Alcohol-Induced Cardiomyopathy

A disease of the heart muscle caused by long-term heavy alcohol use. The heart may enlarge and weaken, so it pumps blood less effectively. This can lead to heart failure or abnormal heart rhythms.

Alcohol Intolerance

An unpleasant reaction after drinking alcohol, often caused by inherited difficulty breaking down alcohol or sensitivity to an ingredient in the drink. Symptoms may include flushing, headache, nausea, rapid heartbeat, or worsening asthma.

Alcohol Intoxication

Temporary impairment caused by drinking alcohol. It can cause poor judgment, confusion, slurred speech, loss of coordination, vomiting, reduced consciousness, slowed breathing, or coma.

Alternate Names:
Alcoholic Intoxication

Alcoholism

Alternate name; see *Alcohol Use Disorder*.

Alcohol Poisoning

A life-threatening overdose of alcohol that severely depresses brain function and can cause vomiting, inability to wake, seizures, slow or irregular breathing, low body temperature, coma, or death.

Alcohol-Related Dementia

A cognitive disorder associated with long-term heavy alcohol use. Brain injury may reflect direct alcohol toxicity, thiamine deficiency, liver disease, vascular injury, or a combination; memory, planning, attention, and other abilities may be affected.

Alternate Names:
Alcoholic Dementia; Alcohol-Induced Major Neurocognitive Disorder

Alcohol-Related Neuropathy

Damage to the peripheral sensory and motor nerves caused by chronic, long-term alcohol abuse and associated nutritional deficiencies, typically presenting with symmetric numbness, paresthesias, burning pain, and muscle weakness beginning in the lower extremities.

Alternate Names:
Alcoholic Neuropathy; Alcoholic Polyneuropathy

Alcohol-Related Psychosis

Hallucinations, delusions, or other psychotic symptoms associated with alcohol use, intoxication, withdrawal, or a coexisting alcohol-related disorder. Similar symptoms can occur in other medical and psychiatric conditions.

Alcohol Swab

A single-use pad moistened with alcohol, usually used to clean intact skin before an injection or other procedure. The skin is allowed to dry before the procedure.

Alcohol Use Disorder

A pattern of alcohol use causing clinically significant distress or impairment, with difficulty controlling use, craving, risky use, or continued use despite harm. Diagnosis requires at least two of 11 symptoms within a 12-month period; severity is mild with 2–3 symptoms, moderate with 4–5, and severe with 6 or more.

Alternate Names:
Alcoholism (older term); Alcohol Dependence (older diagnostic term)

Alcohol Withdrawal

Symptoms that can occur after a person who drinks heavily for a long time suddenly stops or greatly reduces alcohol. Symptoms include shaking, sweating, anxiety, nausea, hallucinations, seizures, and delirium; severe withdrawal can be life-threatening.

Alternate Names:
Alcohol Withdrawal Syndrome

Alcuronium

An older, rarely used nondepolarizing neuromuscular-blocking medicine that temporarily paralyzes skeletal muscles during anesthesia. It can also paralyze the muscles needed for breathing, so it is used only with controlled ventilation and monitoring.

ALD

Abbreviation commonly referring to adrenoleukodystrophy, an inherited disorder of fatty-acid metabolism that can damage the nervous system and adrenal glands.

Aldolase Blood Test

A blood test that measures aldolase, an enzyme found mainly in muscle and liver. A high result may occur with muscle injury or disease, but it is not specific and is interpreted with symptoms and other tests.

Aldosterone

A hormone made by the adrenal glands that helps the kidneys retain sodium and water and remove potassium. It helps control blood volume and blood pressure.

Aldosterone Blood Test

A blood test that measures the hormone aldosterone. It helps investigate high or low blood pressure and abnormal potassium levels and is usually interpreted together with a renin test.

Aldosterone Escape

A physiological phenomenon in primary hyperaldosteronism where persistent mineralocorticoid excess

causes initial sodium and water retention, but subsequent increased atrial natriuretic peptide secretion and pressure natriuresis prevent progressive hypervolemia and severe edema.

Aldosterone-to-Renin Ratio

A clinical screening blood test used in the evaluation of secondary hypertension to detect primary aldosteronism (Conn syndrome). A significantly elevated ratio of plasma aldosterone concentration to plasma renin activity prompts confirmatory testing.

Alternate Names:
ARR

Aldosteronism With Normal Blood Pressure

A form of primary aldosteronism in which excess aldosterone is present without obvious hypertension. It may still cause low potassium, metabolic alkalosis, or cardiovascular and kidney risk.

Alektorophobia

An intense and irrational fear of chickens or other fowl, causing marked anxiety or panic upon exposure to the birds, their feathers, or eggs.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Chickens

Aleukemic Leukemia

A presentation of acute or chronic leukemia in which malignant blasts or abnormal leukocytes are absent or present in extremely low numbers in the peripheral blood smear, despite extensive malignant infiltration of the bone marrow.

Alexander Disease

A rare genetic disorder in which abnormal GFAP protein damages the brain's supporting cells and white matter. It may begin in infancy, childhood, or adulthood and can cause enlarged head size, developmental problems, movement difficulty, seizures, or progressive weakness.

Alternate Names:
Fibrinoid Leukodystrophy; GFAP Leukodystrophy

Alexia

Loss of the ability to understand written words despite adequate eyesight, usually because of brain damage from a stroke, injury, tumour, or degenerative disease. It may occur with other language or reading problems.

Alexia Without Agraphia

A classical neurological disconnection syndrome in which a patient can write spontaneously and to dictation but is completely unable to read printed or handwritten text (including their own writing). Caused by an infarction of the left posterior cerebral artery affecting the left visual cortex and the splenium of the corpus callosum, isolating the intact right visual cortex from the language centers of the left hemisphere.

Alternate Names:
Pure Alexia; Dejerine Syndrome; Pure Word Blindness

Alexithymia

Difficulty recognizing, understanding, or describing one's own emotions. It is a trait or symptom rather than a diagnosis and may occur with autism, depression, trauma, stress, or other conditions.

Alezzandrini Syndrome

An exceptionally rare acquired disorder of unilateral melanocyte destruction involving ipsilateral facial vitiligo and poliosis with retinal or visual abnormalities and sometimes hearing loss. The cause is uncertain, and vision or hearing may progressively worsen.

Alfacalcidol

A medicine related to vitamin D that the liver changes into an active form. It increases absorption of calcium and phosphate and is used for selected disorders of bones, kidneys, or mineral balance.

Algia

A word ending that means pain. It appears in terms such as neuralgia for nerve pain, myalgia for muscle pain, and arthralgia for joint pain; it does not identify the cause.

Alglucerase

An older enzyme-replacement medicine for Gaucher disease, a disorder in which fatty substances build up in cells. It replaces an enzyme the body lacks; newer enzyme preparations are used more often.

Algodystrophy

Older term; see *Complex Regional Pain Syndrome*.

Algoneurodystrophy

Older term; see *Complex Regional Pain Syndrome*.

Algophobia

An abnormal, persistent, and exaggerated fear of experiencing physical pain, often leading to hypervigilance, anticipatory panic, and avoidance of medical procedures or physical activity.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Pain

Algor Mortis

The gradual cooling of the body after death toward the surrounding temperature. The amount of cooling can help estimate the time since death, but it is affected by the environment and other conditions.

Aliasing Artifact

An ultrasound error in which blood flow moving faster than the selected display range appears to change direction or speed. It reflects a limitation of the image display, not necessarily abnormal blood flow.

Alice in Wonderland Syndrome

A rare neurological and perceptual condition characterized by transient distortions of visual perception and body image, in which objects or one's own body parts appear abnormally large (macropsia) or small (micropsia), frequently associated with migraines or Epstein–Barr virus infection.

Alternate Names:
Todd Syndrome; Dysmetropsia

Alien Hand Syndrome

A neurological condition in which an upper limb performs autonomous, purposeful-appearing actions without conscious voluntary control, often accompanied by the patient's sensation that the limb is foreign or acting independently. It is associated with lesions of the corpus callosum, supplementary motor area, or medial frontal cortex.

Alternate Names:
Alien Limb Phenomenon; Anarchic Hand

Alimentary

Relating to eating, digestion, or the movement of food through the body. In medical language, it usually refers to the digestive tract and the organs that help break down and absorb food.

Alimentary Canal

The continuous muscular tube through which food passes from the mouth to the anus. It includes the throat, oesophagus, stomach, small intestine, and large intestine.

Alkalemia

An abnormally elevated arterial blood pH (greater than 7.45), indicating a decreased hydrogen ion concentration in circulating blood. It represents the net systemic state caused by underlying metabolic or respiratory alkalosis.

Alkali

A basic substance that can neutralize acids. Strong alkalis, such as some cleaning chemicals, can burn the skin, eyes, and digestive tract, while weaker alkalis have food, laboratory, or medical uses.

Alkaline Diet

A diet based mainly on foods claimed to make the body more alkaline. The lungs and kidneys tightly control blood acidity, so food does not make the blood alkaline, although many such diets include nutritious foods.

Alkaline Phosphatase

An enzyme found mainly in the liver, bile ducts, bones, intestine, and placenta. A high blood level may reflect liver or bile-duct disease, increased bone activity, pregnancy, or another condition; its source

is clarified by other clinical and laboratory findings.

Alkaline Phosphatase Test

A quantitative serum laboratory assay measuring alkaline phosphatase activity to evaluate suspected cholestatic liver disease, biliary obstruction, or increased bone turnover such as Paget disease or bone metastases.

Alternate Names:
ALP Blood Test; Serum ALP; Alkaline Phosphatase Level

Alkaloid

A naturally occurring chemical containing nitrogen, often made by plants, that can strongly affect the body. Examples include morphine, quinine, nicotine, and atropine.

Alternate Names:
Plant Alkaloid; Basic Nitrogenous Organic Compound

Alkalosis

An abnormal bodily state in which body fluids become too alkaline, raising the blood's pH balance above normal. It is divided into two main types: **respiratory alkalosis**, which happens when rapid or deep breathing (hyperventilation) expels too much carbon dioxide; and **metabolic alkalosis**, which happens when the body loses too much acid (such as from prolonged vomiting or diuretic use) or accumulates too much bicarbonate. Symptoms may include muscle twitches, cramps, numbness, tingling in the fingers or around the mouth, and confusion.

Alkaptonuria

A rare inherited metabolic disorder usually caused by disease-causing variants in both copies of the *HGD* gene, which reduce activity of the enzyme homogentisate 1,2-dioxygenase. Homogentisic acid then builds up; urine may turn dark after standing, and pigment can collect in connective tissues in a process called ochronosis. Over time, this can cause arthritis, especially in the spine and large joints, and sometimes kidney or prostate stones or heart-valve disease.

Alkylating Agents

Drugs or chemicals that damage DNA by attaching chemical groups to it. Some are used to treat cancer by stopping cells from multiplying, but they can also injure healthy cells and cause side effects.

Allantoin

A compound used in some skin products to soften, moisturize, and protect irritated or rough skin. Its effect and safety depend on the product and how it is used.

Allantois

A temporary structure in the early embryo that helps with blood-vessel development and contributes to the umbilical cord and part of the urinary system.

Allele

One of two or more versions of a gene. A person usually inherits one allele from each parent; different alleles can influence traits or the risk of inherited disease.

Allelic

Relating to an allele, one of the different versions of a gene inherited from a parent.

Allen Test

A bedside test that checks whether blood can reach the hand through both of its main arteries. It may be done before taking blood from or placing a catheter in the radial artery.

Allergen

A substance that can provoke an allergic immune response in a person who reacts to it. Allergens include proteins in foods, pollen, animal material, and natural rubber, as well as some medicines and insect venoms. Sensitization to an allergen does not always cause symptoms on exposure.

Allergen Immunotherapy

Treatment that gives gradually increasing amounts of a known allergen by injections or under the tongue. Over time, it can reduce allergic symp-

toms for selected allergies, but it can rarely cause a serious reaction.

Allergic and Environmental Asthma

Asthma triggered or worsened by allergens or environmental exposures such as dust mites, molds, pollens, animals, smoke, air pollution, or workplace agents. It may be associated with allergic sensitization or workplace exposures.

Allergic Asthma

A common asthma phenotype triggered by environmental allergens such as pollen, animal dander, dust mites, or mold. The immune response often involves immunoglobulin E (IgE) and can cause airway inflammation, wheezing, and breathlessness.

Alternate Names:
Atopic Asthma; Extrinsic Asthma

Allergic Bronchopulmonary Aspergillosis

An allergic reaction to the fungus Aspergillus in the airways, occurring mainly in people with asthma or cystic fibrosis. It can cause worsening breathing symptoms, mucus plugs, airway widening, and high levels of allergy-related cells or antibodies.

Allergic Cascade

The chain of immune events that follows exposure to an allergen. Immune cells release substances such as histamine, which can cause itching, swelling, mucus, wheezing, hives, or anaphylaxis.

Allergic Conjunctivitis

Alternate name; see *Eye Allergies*.

Allergic Contact Dermatitis

A delayed type-IV hypersensitivity reaction after skin contact with an allergen to which the immune system has been sensitized. It causes itching, redness, swelling, blisters, scaling, or chronic fissuring, often extending beyond the contact area; patch testing can help identify the trigger.

Allergic Dermatitis

Skin inflammation caused by an immune reaction to an allergen. It commonly causes itching, redness, swelling, blisters, or scaling and may occur after contact with a triggering substance.

Allergic Diseases

Conditions in which the immune system reacts abnormally to a usually harmless substance called an allergen, such as pollen, dust mites, mold, food proteins, medicines, insect venom, or animal proteins. Some reactions involve immunoglobulin E (IgE) antibodies, while others do not. Allergic diseases may affect the nose, eyes, skin, lungs, or digestive system and can cause sneezing, itching, hives, swelling, vomiting, wheezing, or anaphylaxis. Examples include allergic rhinitis, food allergy, drug allergy, allergic conjunctivitis, atopic dermatitis, urticaria, and allergic asthma. Food intolerance is different because it does not involve an immune reaction.

Allergic Proctocolitis

A benign, non-IgE-mediated food protein-induced inflammatory disorder of the distal colon and rectum, seen predominantly in young infants exposed to cow's milk or soy protein in formula or breast milk, classically causing blood- and mucus-streaked stools in an otherwise thriving baby.

Alternate Names:
Food Protein-Induced Allergic Proctocolitis; FPIP

Allergic Reaction

An immune response to a usually harmless substance. It may cause sneezing, itching, hives, swelling, vomiting, or breathing difficulty and can sometimes become life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Reactions

Allergic Rhinitis

Inflammation inside the nose caused by an allergic reaction to inhaled substances such as pollen, dust mites, mold, or animal proteins. It causes sneezing, itching, a blocked or runny nose, and sometimes itchy, watery eyes.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Rhinoconjunctivitis

Allergic Shiners

Dark, symmetrical, bluish-purple circles or discolorations beneath the lower eyelids caused by venous congestion in the peri-orbital plexus, secondary to chronic nasal congestion and mucosal swelling from allergic rhinitis.

Alternate Names:
Periorbital Venous Congestion

Allergic Urticaria

Hives caused by an allergic reaction, often involving immunoglobulin E (IgE). Itchy raised welts appear and usually fade within 24 hours, though new ones may develop. Many cases of hives are not caused by allergy.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Hives

Allergies

Exaggerated, hypersensitive immune reactions to foreign substances (allergens) that are typically harmless to most individuals. Common allergens include foods, pollen, animal proteins, insect venoms, and medications, triggering symptoms from mild rhinitis and urticaria to severe anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Reactions

Allergies: Shellfish

An immunoglobulin E-mediated food allergy to proteins found in crustaceans (such as shrimp, crab, and lobster) or mollusks (such as clams, oysters, and squid). Manifestations range from hives, lip swelling, and abdominal cramps to life-threatening systemic anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Shellfish Allergy

Allergies to Insect Stings

Allergic reactions to venom from bees, wasps, hornets, or fire ants. Severe reactions can cause hives, throat swelling, wheezing, low blood pressure, or collapse.

Allergist

A physician specializing in allergic and immunologic disorders, including asthma, allergic rhinitis, food allergy, and immune deficiencies. Allergists assess symptoms and test findings to distinguish allergy from other immune or respiratory conditions.

Allergy

An immune response to a usually harmless substance such as pollen, food, medicine, insect venom, or animal proteins. Symptoms range from sneezing, itching, and hives to swelling, breathing difficulty, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Hypersensitivity

Allergy Shots

Injections used for allergen immunotherapy. They contain gradually increasing amounts of a specific allergen to reduce sensitivity over time and are given in a setting where a serious allergic reaction can be recognized and treated.

Allergy Skin Test

An in vivo diagnostic procedure in which small amounts of suspected allergens are introduced into or onto the skin via prick, puncture, scratch, or intradermal injection to assess immediate IgE-mediated hypersensitivity through localized wheal-and-flare reactions.

Alternate Names:
Skin Prick Test; Allergy Skin Testing

Allergy Test

A skin or blood test used to look for sensitivity to a suspected allergen. A positive result shows sensitization but does not always establish that exposure causes symptoms; clinical relevance depends on the exposure history.

Alternate Names:
Allergy Testing

Allergy to Natural Rubber (Latex)

An immune reaction to natural rubber latex that may cause contact dermatitis, hives, wheezing, or

anaphylaxis. Reactions range from localized skin symptoms to systemic hypersensitivity.

Allis Clamp

A surgical instrument with small teeth used to hold firm tissue during an operation. It provides a strong grip but can injure delicate tissue if applied with too much pressure.

Allocheiria

A neurological sign in which a person feels or identifies a touch on the opposite side of the body from where it was applied. It reflects impaired localization of sensation and may occur with disorders affecting the parietal lobe.

Alternate Names:
Allochiria

Allodynia

Pain caused by something that normally should not hurt, such as light touch, clothing, or gentle pressure. It can occur with nerve injury, migraine, shingles, fibromyalgia, or other pain conditions.

Allogeneic

Coming from another person of the same species who is genetically different, as in an allogeneic blood, tissue, stem-cell, or organ transplant.

Allograft

An organ, tissue, or group of cells transplanted from one genetically different individual to another individual of the same species. The recipient's immune system may reject it, so immunosuppressive medicines may be needed.

Allosteric Regulation

Control of a protein or enzyme when another molecule attaches away from its main working site. The attachment changes the protein's shape and can increase or decrease how well it works.

AloBar Holoprosencephaly

Alobar holoprosencephaly is the most severe form of holoprosencephaly, in which the developing forebrain fails to divide into two cerebral hemispheres. It is usually associated with major brain and facial abnormalities and profound developmental impairment.

Aloe

A plant used in some skin products, medicines, and supplements. Aloe gel applied to skin may soothe minor irritation, while products containing aloe latex taken by mouth can cause cramps, diarrhoea, and dangerous fluid or salt loss.

Aloe Vera

A common name for Aloe species whose inner-leaf gel is used in some skin products and supplements. Oral aloe latex and some whole-leaf products can cause diarrhea, fluid or salt loss, medicine interactions, or toxicity.

Alogia

Markedly reduced speech or speech that conveys little information. It may occur as a negative symptom of schizophrenia and can also be associated with depression, brain disease, or other conditions.

Alongshan Virus

A segmented RNA virus detected in ticks and associated with human febrile illness, first identified in northeastern China. Reported symptoms include fever, headache, fatigue, muscle aches, and sometimes neurologic findings; its clinical significance and geographic distribution remain under study.

Alopecia

Hair loss from the scalp or another part of the body. It may be nonscarring, in which the hair follicles remain and hair may regrow, or scarring, in which inflammation or injury destroys the follicles and can cause permanent hair loss. Causes include inherited pattern hair loss, autoimmune disease, hormonal changes, illness, medicines, nutritional problems, infection, repeated pulling, or other injury. The amount, pattern, and speed of hair loss vary with the cause.

Alopecia Areata

An autoimmune, usually nonscarring hair-loss disorder in which immune cells attack anagen hair follicles. It often causes sharply demarcated smooth patches with exclamation-mark hairs and may involve the scalp, beard, eyebrows, or nails; regrowth is possible but relapses and extensive forms can occur.

Alternate Names:
AA; Patchy Hair Loss; Autoimmune Alopecia

Alopecia Celsi

An older name for alopecia areata, an autoimmune disorder causing sharply defined patches of nonscarring hair loss.

Alopecia Cicatrisata

Older term; see *Scarring Alopecia*.

Alopecia Circumscripta

An older name for alopecia areata, characterized by one or more circumscribed patches of nonscarring hair loss.

Alopecia Mucinosa (Follicular Mucinosis)

A skin disorder in which mucin accumulates within hair follicles and sebaceous glands, causing itchy follicular papules or plaques with hair loss. It may be a primary self-limited condition or a cutaneous sign of lymphoma, especially mycosis fungoides; persistent or widespread forms are more often associated with lymphoma.

Alopecia Totalis

A form of alopecia areata causing complete loss of hair from the scalp. Hair may regrow, remain absent, or fall out again; other autoimmune conditions may coexist.

Alopecia Universalis

Complete or near-complete loss of hair from the scalp and body, usually caused by extensive alopecia areata. Hair may regrow or recur unpredictably.

ALP Blood Test

Alternate index label; see *Alkaline Phosphatase Test*.

Alpers Disease

A rare, progressive autosomal recessive neurodegenerative disorder of early childhood caused by mutations in the nuclear gene *POLG*, characterized by the clinical triad of intractable seizures, psychomotor regression, and progressive liver failure.

Alternate Names:
Alpers-Huttenlocher Syndrome; Progressive Infantile Poliodystrophy

Alpha-1

An abbreviation that may refer to alpha-1 antitrypsin, its deficiency, or a test for the protein; its meaning depends on context.

Alpha-1 Adrenergic Antagonist

A medicine or other substance that blocks alpha-1 adrenergic receptors. This reduces selected effects of noradrenaline on vascular smooth muscle and other tissues; the precise effects depend on the receptor distribution and the substance used.

Alternate Names:
Alpha-1 Adrenergic Blocker

Alpha1-Antitrypsin (AAT) Deficiency

Alternate name; see *Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency*.

Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Blood Test

A blood test that measures alpha-1 antitrypsin, a protein made by the liver that helps protect lung tissue. A low level may suggest inherited alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency, which can affect the lungs and liver.

Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency

An autosomal codominant genetic disorder caused by variants in the *SERPINA1* gene that lead to deficient or dysfunctional alpha-1 antitrypsin (AAT). The deficiency permits uninhibited neutrophil elastase destruction of pulmonary elastin, resulting in early-onset panacinar emphysema (markedly accel-

erated by smoking). Hepatocyte retention of polymerized mutant protein (most commonly the Pi*ZZ genotype) causes neonatal cholestasis, cirrhosis, and hepatocellular carcinoma. Panniculitis and ANCA-associated vasculitis may also occur.

Alternate Names:
AATD; A1AT Deficiency; AAT Deficiency; Alpha-1 Deficiency

Alpha-Agonists

Medicines that activate alpha receptors on cells. Depending on the medicine and tissue, they can narrow blood vessels, raise blood pressure, reduce eye fluid, or affect the nervous system.

Alpha Blockers

Medicines that relax certain blood vessels and smooth muscles by blocking alpha receptors. They may lower blood pressure or improve urine flow in an enlarged prostate, but can cause dizziness or fainting.

Alpha Cells

Cells in the pancreas that make glucagon. Glucagon raises blood glucose when it falls too low or when the body needs energy between meals.

Alternate Names:
Pancreatic Alpha Cells; Glucagon-Secreting Cells

Alpha-Fetoprotein

A protein made mainly by a developing fetus. Measuring it in maternal blood can help screen for some fetal conditions, while measuring it in adults can help assess selected liver or germ-cell tumours. An abnormal result does not establish a diagnosis.

Alpha-Fetoprotein Test

A blood test measuring alpha-fetoprotein, a fetal plasma protein utilized as a tumor marker for hepatocellular carcinoma and germ cell tumors, or in prenatal screening for neural tube defects; see *Alpha-Fetoprotein*.

Alpha-Gal Syndrome

An allergy to a sugar found in most mammals but not humans or other primates. It can cause delayed hives, stomach symptoms, or anaphylaxis after eating mammalian meat or using some animal-derived products.

Alternate Names:
Alpha-Gal Allergy

Alpha-Globulin

One of several groups of proteins in the liquid part of blood. These proteins carry substances and help with inflammation, clotting, and immune defence; their levels may change with liver disease, inflammation, or other conditions.

Alpha-Glucosidase Inhibitors

Diabetes medicines that slow the digestion and absorption of carbohydrates in the small intestine. They mainly reduce the rise in blood glucose after meals and may cause gas, bloating, or diarrhoea.

Alpha Hydroxy Acids

A group of acids used in skin products to loosen the outer layer of skin and improve roughness, fine lines, or uneven colour. Common examples are glycolic acid and lactic acid; they can irritate skin and increase sun sensitivity.

Alternate Names:
AHAs; Fruit Acids

Alpha-Ketoglutarate

A substance made during the breakdown of nutrients for energy. It also helps the body process amino acids and supports several chemical reactions inside cells.

Alpha-Mannosidosis

An autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient lysosomal alpha-mannosidase, usually due to biallelic variants in *MAN2B1*. Mannose-rich oligosaccharides accumulate in cells and damage multiple tissues. Manifestations vary in onset and severity and can include developmental impairment, hearing loss, recurrent infections, skeletal abnormalities, ataxia, and enlargement of the liver and spleen.

Alternate Names:

Alpha-D-Mannosidosis; Alpha-Mannosidase Deficiency

Alpha-Synuclein

A protein found mainly in nerve cells that helps regulate nerve-cell functions. Abnormal forms can collect into clumps in Parkinson disease, Lewy-body dementia, and related disorders, although the clumps are not the only cause of these diseases.

Alpha-Thalassemia

An inherited blood disorder, usually autosomal recessive, in which the body makes too little alpha-globin, a part of hemoglobin that carries oxygen. The condition may cause no symptoms, mild anemia, or severe anemia before or shortly after birth, depending on the number of affected alpha-globin genes.

Alternate Names:
Alpha Thalassaemia

Alpha Waves

A regular pattern of electrical activity in the brain, usually eight to thirteen cycles per second. It is strongest when a relaxed, awake person has closed eyes and decreases with attention or eye opening.

Alternate Names:
Alpha Rhythm; Posterior Dominant Rhythm

ALP Isoenzyme Test

A blood test that helps identify whether a high alkaline phosphatase level comes mainly from the liver, bones, intestine, or placenta. It can help distinguish liver or bile-duct disease from increased bone activity.

Alport Syndrome

An inherited disorder of collagen that can cause progressive kidney disease, hearing loss, and changes in the eyes. It may be caused by changes in the *COL4A3*, *COL4A4*, or *COL4A5* genes and may follow X-linked, autosomal dominant, or autosomal recessive inheritance.

Alprazolam

A benzodiazepine medicine used for anxiety and panic disorder. It calms brain activity but can cause sleepiness, impaired coordination, dependence, and dangerous slowing of breathing, especially with opioids or alcohol.

Alstrom Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder caused by changes in the ALMS1 gene. It may cause progressive vision and hearing loss, obesity, diabetes or insulin resistance, heart disease, and kidney or liver problems.

Alternate Names:
Alström Syndrome

Altered Mental Status

A broad clinical term denoting any disruption in baseline cognitive function, alertness, or awareness, encompassing states ranging from acute delirium, confusion, and agitation to lethargy, stupor, and coma. Common etiologies include metabolic derangements, infections, toxins, and intracranial events.

Alternate Names:
AMS; Altered Sensorium

Alternating Hemiplegia Of Childhood

A rare neurological disorder beginning in infancy or early childhood, causing recurrent episodes of temporary paralysis that may affect either side of the body. Episodes may also involve abnormal movements, eye-movement problems, breathing difficulty, seizures, and developmental impairment; symptoms typically disappear during sleep.

Altitude Headache

Headache related to ascent to high altitude, often as part of acute mountain sickness. It may occur with nausea, dizziness, fatigue, or sleep disturbance and can signal more serious altitude illness when severe or accompanied by neurologic or breathing symptoms.

Altitude Illness

Illness caused by rapid ascent to high altitude without enough time to adjust. It includes acute moun-

tain sickness, high-altitude brain swelling, and high-altitude lung swelling; severe forms can be fatal.

Alternate Names:
Altitude Sickness

Aluminum Phosphide

A highly poisonous pesticide that releases phosphine gas when it contacts moisture or stomach acid. Poisoning can rapidly damage the heart, lungs, digestive system, and other organs.

Aluminum Toxicity

Toxicity from excessive aluminum exposure or accumulation, especially in advanced kidney disease or with contaminated dialysis products. Chronic exposure can cause encephalopathy, speech or movement changes, microcytic anemia, and bone pain or osteomalacia; evaluation includes exposure review, kidney function, and specialist-directed aluminum testing.

Alvarado Score

A clinical score used to estimate the likelihood of acute appendicitis from symptoms, examination findings, and blood-test results. It supports assessment but does not by itself confirm or exclude appendicitis.

Alveolar

Relating to an alveolus, especially one of the tiny air sacs in the lungs where oxygen enters the blood and carbon dioxide leaves it.

Alveolar Abnormalities

Changes in the lung air sacs that can interfere with oxygen and carbon-dioxide exchange. They may occur with infection, fluid buildup, emphysema, scarring, or a developmental condition.

Alveolar Adenoma

A rare, benign, well-circumscribed epithelial neoplasm of the lung, composed of cystic spaces lined by alveolar epithelial cells with a supporting stromal component. It generally appears as a solitary pulmonary nodule and may be found incidentally. It is distinct from malignant lung tumours, although imaging alone may not establish its histology.

Alveolar-Arterial Oxygen Gradient

The difference between oxygen pressure in the lung air sacs and oxygen pressure in arterial blood. It is calculated as PAO2 minus PaO2. A high value may indicate a problem with oxygen transfer, blood flow through the lungs, or lung tissue. A normal value with low blood oxygen may suggest slow breathing or low oxygen in the surrounding air.

Alternate Names:
A-a Gradient; A-a Oxygen Difference

Alveolar Bone

The part of the jawbone that surrounds and supports the roots of the teeth. It can shrink after tooth loss and may need rebuilding before some dental implants.

Alveolar Bone Loss

Loss of the bone that supports the teeth, most often caused by periodontitis. It can make teeth loose and may lead to tooth loss; dental treatment can slow further loss.

Alveolar-Capillary Barrier

The delicate biological membrane formed by the alveolar type I pneumocyte, capillary endothelial cell, and their intervening fused basement membranes, through which oxygen and carbon dioxide diffuse between alveolar air and capillary blood.

Alternate Names:
Alveolar-Capillary Membrane; Blood-Air Barrier

Alveolar Dead Space

The volume of inhaled air that reaches alveoli that are adequately ventilated but lack sufficient pulmonary capillary blood perfusion, preventing gas exchange from taking place.

Alveolar Echinococcosis

A rare, serious infection caused by the young form of the Echinococcus multilocularis tapeworm, usually after swallowing contaminated food or water. It creates slowly growing, tumor-like areas in the liver

that can invade nearby tissue or spread.

Alternate Names:
Alveolar Hydatid Disease

Alveolar Gas Equation

A formula used to estimate the oxygen level in the lung air sacs from the inhaled oxygen level and carbon-dioxide level. Comparing this estimate with arterial blood oxygen helps assess how well the lungs exchange gases.

Alveolar Hypoventilation

Deficient ventilation of the pulmonary alveoli resulting in reduced carbon dioxide elimination, leading to arterial hypercapnia and respiratory acidosis.

Alveolar Macrophage

An immune cell that lives in the lung air sacs and removes inhaled dust, microbes, and damaged cells. It also helps regulate inflammation in the lungs.

Alternate Names:
Dust Cell

Alveolar Osteitis

Painful inflammation of a tooth socket after extraction, usually caused by loss or breakdown of the blood clot that normally protects the socket.

Alternate Names:
Dry Socket; Fibrinolytic Alveolitis

Alveolar Proteinosis

Alternate form; see *Pulmonary Alveolar Proteinosis*.

Alveolar Rhabdomyosarcoma

A cancer of immature muscle-forming cells, usually affecting children or adolescents. It may arise in the limbs, trunk, head, or neck and can spread early to lymph nodes, lungs, bones, or other tissues.

Alveolar Ventilation

The amount of fresh air reaching the lung air sacs each minute and available for oxygen and carbon-dioxide exchange. It depends on breathing rate, breath size, and the amount of air remaining in the breathing passages.

Alveolar Ventilation Equation

A relationship showing how breathing affects blood carbon-dioxide levels. When the amount of fresh air reaching the lung air sacs falls, carbon dioxide rises; when effective breathing increases, carbon dioxide falls, if production stays constant.

Alveolitis

Inflammation of the lung air sacs, usually causing cough and shortness of breath, or inflammation of a tooth socket after extraction, called dry socket. The body site identifies the meaning.

Alveolus

One of the microscopic air sacs at the ends of the lung airways. Oxygen passes from an alveolus into the blood and carbon dioxide passes from the blood into it.

Alzheimer Disease

A progressive brain disease and the most common cause of dementia. It slowly damages nerve cells and the connections between them. Early symptoms often include trouble remembering recent events, finding words, or planning tasks. As the disease advances, it can affect language, judgment, orientation, behavior, and daily activities. Beta-amyloid protein can collect in plaques between nerve cells, and tau protein can form tangles inside them; these changes are linked to brain damage. Alzheimer disease is not a normal part of aging, although risk increases with age.

Alternate Names:
Alzheimer's Disease; Alzheimer's

Alzheimer's

Alternate name; see *Alzheimer Disease*.

Amalgam

A dental filling material made by combining mercury with metals such as silver, tin, and copper. It is strong and durable but has a metallic appearance and may not be suitable for every person or tooth.

Amastia

A birth condition in which one or both breasts do not develop. The nipple, chest muscle, or other nearby structures may also be absent or underdeveloped.

Amaurosis

Partial or complete loss of vision, which may be temporary or permanent and may result from disease of the eye, retina, optic nerve, or visual pathways in the brain.

Amaurosis Fugax

Sudden, temporary loss of vision in one eye, usually caused by brief retinal ischemia, often from an embolus. It is a form of retinal transient ischemia that can signal vascular disease and increased stroke risk.

Amaxophobia

An intense, disproportionate fear of riding in or driving a vehicle, such as an automobile, producing pronounced anxiety or avoidance behavior.

Alternate Names:
Motophobia; Fear of Driving

Ambidextrous

Able to use the left and right hands with similar skill. It describes a pattern of handedness, not a disease.

Ambient

Surrounding or present in the immediate environment, such as ambient temperature, light, noise, or air.

Ambiguous Genitalia

External genital anatomy that does not have typical male or female features. It usually reflects a difference in sex development, which may involve chromosomes, hormones, or the formation of reproductive organs.

Amblyopia

Reduced vision in one or, rarely, both eyes because the visual system did not develop normally during childhood. It can result from misaligned eyes, unequal focusing between the eyes, or something that blocks clear vision. The eye may look normal, although a cause such as a cataract or drooping eyelid may be visible. Earlier onset and longer duration are associated with greater effects on visual development.

Alternate Names:
Lazy Eye; Functional Amblyopia; Visual Suppression Amblyopia

Ambu Bag

A self-inflating manual resuscitator, commonly called a bag-valve mask, used with a face mask or airway device to provide positive-pressure ventilation when breathing is inadequate. Ambu is a brand name often used generically.

Ambulatory Blood Pressure Monitoring

Measurement of blood pressure at regular intervals, usually for twenty-four hours, with a portable cuff worn during normal activities and sleep. It can identify blood-pressure patterns that may not appear during a clinic visit.

Amebiasis

An infection caused by the parasite Entamoeba histolytica, usually spread by swallowing contaminated food, water, or material from contaminated hands. It may cause no symptoms, diarrhea, abdominal pain, or bloody diarrhea. In some cases, the infection can spread from the intestine to the liver.

Alternate Names:
Entamoeba Histolytica Infection

Amebic Colitis

Inflammation of the large intestine caused by Entamoeba histolytica. It may cause abdominal pain, diarrhoea, bloody stools, or fever.

Alternate Names:
Amoebic Colitis

Amebic Dysentery

An acute, invasive intestinal infection caused by the protozoan parasite Entamoeba histolytica, characterized by extensive ulceration of the colonic mucosa

("flask-shaped" ulcers). Patients typically present with severe lower abdominal cramping, tenesmus, and frequent passage of bloody, mucoid stools, with potential complications including fulminant necrotizing colitis, toxic megacolon, bowel perforation, and secondary amebic liver abscess.

Alternate Names:
Amoebic Dysentery

Amebic Liver Abscess

A collection of infected or damaged tissue in the liver caused by the parasite *Entamoeba histolytica*. It often affects the right side of the liver and may cause fever, pain under the right ribs, and an enlarged or tender liver. Imaging and blood tests can support the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Amoebic Liver Abscess; Hepatic Amebiasis; Entamoeba Liver Abscess

Amebic Meningoencephalitis

A rare, rapidly progressing, and severe infection of the brain and its surrounding membranes caused by the free-living amoeba Naegleria fowleri. It typically occurs when warm freshwater containing the amoeba enters the nasal cavity during swimming, diving, or nasal rinsing, allowing the organism to travel along the nerves to the brain. Symptoms include intense frontal headache, high fever, stiff neck, nausea, vomiting, confusion, seizures, and coma.

Alternate Names:
Primary Amebic Meningoencephalitis; PAM; Primary Amoebic Meningoencephalitis

Ameboma

A chronic, localized inflammatory granulomatous pseudotumor of the bowel wall that develops in a minority of patients with untreated or inadequately treated Entamoeba histolytica infection, most commonly affecting the cecum or ascending colon. It presents as a palpable, tender right-lower-quadrant abdominal mass associated with intermittent bloody diarrhea, obstruction, or weight loss, frequently mimicking colonic adenocarcinoma on colonoscopy and cross-sectional imaging.

Alternate Names:
Amoeboma; Amebic Granuloma

Amelanotic Melanoma

A melanoma that produces little or no dark pigment and may appear pink, red, or skin-coloured instead of black or brown. Its appearance can delay recognition; diagnosis requires examination of a tissue sample.

Amelia

A rare birth condition in which one or more arms or legs are completely absent. It may occur alone or with other developmental differences.

Amelioration

Improvement or reduction in the severity, frequency, or effect of a symptom, disease, impairment, or other harmful condition.

Ameloblastoma

A usually slow-growing tumour that begins in cells involved in tooth development, most often in the lower jaw. It can grow into nearby bone, deform the jaw, and return after treatment.

Amelogenesis

The process by which developing teeth form and harden enamel, the tough outer covering of each tooth. Problems with this process can make enamel thin, weak, discoloured, or easily damaged.

Amelogenesis Imperfecta

A group of inherited conditions in which tooth enamel does not form normally. The enamel may be thin, soft, rough, discoloured, or easily worn on most or all teeth.

Amenorrhea

Absence of menstrual periods. Primary amenorrhea means menstruation has not started by the expected age; secondary amenorrhea means periods stop after they have begun. It may be normal during pregnancy, breastfeeding, or menopause, or may result from hormonal, reproductive, medical, nutritional, or exercise-related conditions.

Amenorrhea (Absence of Menstruation)

Alternate name; see *Amenorrhea*.

American Trypanosomiasis

Alternate name; see *Chagas Disease*.

Ametropia

A focusing problem in which the eye does not bring incoming light to a sharp focus on the retina. Nearsightedness, farsightedness, and astigmatism are common forms and can cause blurred vision.

Amino Acid

A small molecule used to build proteins. Amino acids also support energy production and other chemical processes in the body.

Amino Acid Catabolism

The body's breakdown of amino acids after proteins are digested. Their nitrogen part is removed and safely processed, while the remaining part is used to make energy, glucose, ketones, or other substances.

Amino Acid Symbols

The standard one-letter and three-letter abbreviations used to identify the 20 amino acids most commonly used to build proteins. They make genetic, laboratory, and biochemical information shorter and easier to compare.

Aminoaciduria

Abnormally large amounts of amino acids in the urine, usually because the kidney tubules cannot reabsorb them properly or because of an inherited metabolic disorder.

Aminoglycoside Nephrotoxicity

Kidney injury caused by aminoglycoside antibiotics, which can build up in kidney cells. Risk increases with high doses, prolonged treatment, existing kidney disease, or other kidney-toxic medicines.

Aminoglycoside Ototoxicity

Inner-ear damage caused by aminoglycoside antibiotics, which may lead to hearing loss, ringing in the ears, dizziness, or balance problems. Risk increases with high or prolonged exposure.

Aminoglycosides

A group of antibiotics that kill certain bacteria by stopping them from making essential proteins. Examples include gentamicin, tobramycin, amikacin, and streptomycin; they can damage the kidneys and inner ear.

Aminophylline Overdose

Poisoning caused by too much aminophylline, a medicine that opens narrowed airways. It can cause vomiting, tremor, rapid or irregular heartbeat, low blood pressure, seizures, or dangerous changes in blood chemistry.

Aminotransferase

An enzyme that helps cells process amino acids, the building blocks of proteins. Blood levels of ALT and AST may rise when liver, muscle, or other cells are injured, but the result does not identify the cause alone.

Amiodarone

An antiarrhythmic medicine used to treat selected abnormal heart rhythms, including atrial fibrillation and ventricular tachycardia. It can affect the lungs, liver, thyroid, eyes, skin, nerves, and heart rhythm.

Amiodarone-Induced Skin Discoloration

A blue-grey or slate-grey darkening of sun-exposed skin caused by long-term amiodarone treatment. It is more likely with higher doses and may fade partly after the medicine is stopped.

Amiodarone-Induced Thyroid Dysfunction

An overactive or underactive thyroid caused by amiodarone. The medicine contains iodine and can either increase thyroid-hormone production or inflame and damage the thyroid.

Amiodarone-Induced Vortex Keratopathy

Whorl-shaped deposits in the surface layer of the

cornea caused by amiodarone. They usually cause no symptoms but may produce halos around lights and generally improve after the medicine is stopped.

Amiodarone Pulmonary Toxicity

Lung injury caused by amiodarone, most often presenting as interstitial pneumonitis but also as organizing pneumonia, diffuse alveolar damage, or pulmonary fibrosis. Symptoms may include progressive breathlessness and cough. Foamy alveolar macrophages can occur but are not specific for toxicity.

Alternate Names:
Amiodarone Lung; Amiodarone-Induced Pneumonitis

Amitriptyline

A tricyclic antidepressant that changes serotonin and noradrenaline signalling in the brain. It is also used for some nerve pain and migraine prevention; common effects include sleepiness, dry mouth, and constipation.

Amitriptyline And Perphenazine Overdose

Poisoning caused by taking too much amitriptyline and perphenazine. It can cause severe sleepiness, confusion, seizures, low blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, coma, or breathing problems.

Amitriptyline Hydrochloride Overdose

Poisoning caused by taking too much amitriptyline. It can cause severe sleepiness, confusion, seizures, low blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, coma, or breathing problems.

Ammonia

A nitrogen-containing waste product made when the body processes proteins. The liver normally changes it into urea for removal; high blood levels can affect brain function, especially in severe liver disease.

Ammonia Blood Test

A blood test that measures ammonia, a waste product normally cleared by the liver. A high result may occur with severe liver disease, inherited metabolic conditions, some medicines, or other illnesses; the level does not always match the severity of symptoms.

Ammonia Poisoning

Injury caused by breathing, swallowing, or getting concentrated ammonia on the skin or eyes. It can burn tissues and cause coughing, breathing difficulty, chest pain, or serious lung damage.

Ammonia Toxicity

Injury caused by inhaling or swallowing ammonia, or by contact with the skin or eyes. Concentrated exposure can cause tissue burns, cough, bronchospasm, laryngeal injury, or pulmonary edema.

Ammonium Hydroxide Poisoning

Injury caused by exposure to ammonium hydroxide, a corrosive chemical found in some cleaners and industrial products. It can burn the skin, eyes, mouth, throat, lungs, and digestive tract.

Amnesia

Loss or impairment of memory beyond ordinary forgetfulness. It may prevent a person from forming new memories, recalling past events, or doing both, and may result from brain injury, illness, medicines, or emotional trauma.

Amnestic Syndrome

A pattern of memory impairment that significantly affects learning, storing, or recalling information. It may occur with brain injury, stroke, dementia, epilepsy, substance use, or other neurological conditions.

Amniocentesis

A procedure in which a thin needle removes a small sample of fluid from around the developing baby. The sample can be tested for genetic, chromosomal, or infection-related conditions.

Amnioinfusion

A procedure that adds sterile fluid to the sac around

the developing baby, usually during labour, to reduce pressure on the umbilical cord or dilute thick meconium.

Amnion

The thin inner membrane forming the fluid-filled sac around the developing baby. It holds the amniotic fluid and helps protect the fetus during pregnancy.

Amnion Nodosum

Small deposits of fetal skin material or other debris attached to the inner membrane of the pregnancy sac. They are usually linked with too little amniotic fluid, often because the developing baby is making less urine.

Amnioscope

An instrument formerly inserted through the cervix to examine the amniotic fluid and membranes. It is now rarely used and has largely been superseded by ultrasound.

Amniotic Band

A strand of amniotic membrane that can wrap around a developing body part, restricting growth or blood flow and causing a deformity or loss of tissue.

Amniotic Band Sequence

A group of birth differences caused when strands of the amniotic membrane wrap around or attach to developing fetal parts. Effects may include constriction rings, missing digits, limb defects, or facial and body-wall abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
Amniotic Constriction Band Sequence; ADAM Complex; Streeter Dysplasia

Amniotic Band Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Amniotic Band Sequence*.

Amniotic Fluid

The liquid surrounding the developing baby inside the amniotic sac. It cushions the baby, allows movement and growth, and helps maintain a stable environment during pregnancy. It is continually produced, swallowed, and replaced.

Amniotic Fluid Embolism

A rare, life-threatening syndrome that usually begins during labour or soon after birth with sudden breathing or heart failure and often severe bleeding. Its exact cause is not fully understood; it is associated with fetal material entering the pregnant person's circulation.

Amniotic Fluid Index

An ultrasound estimate of the amount of fluid around the developing baby. It adds the deepest fluid measurements from four areas of the uterus and helps identify unusually low or high fluid levels.

Alternate Names:
AFI; Amniotic Fluid Volume Assessment

Amniotic Sac

The thin, fluid-filled membrane around the developing baby in the uterus. It contains amniotic fluid, cushions the fetus, and usually breaks near or during labour when the waters break.

Amok

An old, culture-related term for a sudden episode of uncontrolled, often violent behaviour followed by exhaustion or memory loss. Modern assessment considers medical, neurological, psychiatric, substance-related, and cultural factors.

AMP-Activated Protein Kinase

A master cellular energy-sensing serine/threonine kinase activated during metabolic stress when intracellular AMP-to-ATP or ADP-to-ATP ratios rise (such as during exercise, hypoxia, or fasting). Once activated, it restores energy homeostasis by promoting ATP-generating catabolic processes (such as glucose uptake via GLUT4, fatty acid oxidation, glycolysis, and autophagy) while suppressing ATP-consuming anabolic pathways (such as lipid synthesis, protein synthesis via mTOR inhibition, and gluconeogenesis). It is a primary molecular target of the antidiabetic drug metformin.

Alternate Names:

AMPK; 5'-AMP-Activated Protein Kinase

Amphetamine

A stimulant medicine that increases certain chemical signals in the brain. It is used for selected attention, activity, or sleep disorders; misuse can cause dependence, high blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, or psychosis.

Amphetamine-Related Psychiatric Disorders

Psychiatric syndromes associated with amphetamine exposure, including intoxication, withdrawal, substance-induced psychosis, mood symptoms, anxiety, or a stimulant use disorder.

Amphetamine Substance Use

Use of amphetamine-type stimulants, which can be associated with insomnia, anxiety, psychosis, high blood pressure, arrhythmias, overheating, dependence, and overdose.

Amphetamine Toxicity

A sympathomimetic syndrome caused by amphetamine or related stimulants. Features can include agitation, dilated pupils, sweating, rapid heart rate, high blood pressure, hyperthermia, chest pain, seizures, or psychosis; severe cases may involve stroke, rhabdomyolysis, or cardiac ischemia.

Amplified Musculoskeletal Pain Syndrome

A condition, often affecting children or teenagers, in which the nervous system increases normal pain signals. Pain may be severe or widespread and can occur with sensitivity, fatigue, swelling, or difficulty using the affected area.

Ampulla

A widened part of a tube-shaped body structure. Examples include the ampulla where the bile and pancreatic ducts join the intestine and the ampulla of a fallopian tube.

Ampulla of Vater

An anatomical dilation located within the medial wall of the descending duodenum, formed by the union of the common bile duct and the main pancreatic duct, draining into the duodenal lumen via the major duodenal papilla.

Alternate Names:
Hepatopancreatic Ampulla

Ampullary Carcinoma

A malignant epithelial tumor arising in or around the ampulla of Vater, where the bile duct and pancreatic duct enter the duodenum. It can block bile flow and cause jaundice, abnormal liver tests, pancreatitis, or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Ampullary Cancer

Ampullary Tubal Ectopic Pregnancy

A tubal ectopic pregnancy implanted in the ampulla, the widened middle portion of a fallopian tube between the isthmus and infundibulum. The ampulla is a common site of ectopic implantation. The pregnancy may cause pelvic pain or vaginal bleeding; rupture can lead to internal hemorrhage.

Amputation

Surgical removal of all or part of a limb, finger, toe, or other body part, often because of severe injury, infection, poor blood flow, or cancer. Traumatic amputation is tissue loss caused by an injury. The level removed depends on healthy tissue, blood supply, healing, and expected function.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Amputation; Limb Removal

Amputation Stump

The part of a limb left after amputation. It may develop wound problems, infection, poor circulation, nerve pain, phantom-limb pain, or skin irritation from a prosthesis.

Amsler Grid

A small square chart used to check central vision. Wavy, missing, or distorted lines may indicate a

problem in the macula and are evaluated with a complete eye examination.

Amusia

Difficulty recognizing, understanding, or producing music despite adequate hearing. It may be present from birth or develop after brain injury, stroke, or another neurological condition.

Amygdala

A group of nerve cells deep in each side of the brain that helps process emotions, especially fear, and contributes to learning, memory, and responses to important or threatening events.

Alternate Names:
Amygdaloid Nucleus

Amylase

An enzyme that begins breaking down starch. It is made mainly by the salivary glands and pancreas and can be measured in blood or urine when pancreatic or salivary-gland disease is suspected.

Amylase And Lipase

Blood tests for digestive enzymes used when pancreatic disease is suspected. Lipase is generally more specific for pancreatic injury, but neither test alone confirms acute pancreatitis.

Amylase Test

A blood or urine test that measures the amount of amylase, an enzyme made mainly by the salivary glands and pancreas. It may help assess pancreatitis and other problems affecting the pancreas or salivary glands.

Alternate Names:
Serum Amylase; Blood Amylase Test; Amylase Blood Test

Amylin Analogues

Medicines that imitate amylin, a hormone released by the pancreas with insulin. They slow stomach emptying, reduce the rise in blood glucose after meals, and reduce glucagon release.

Amyloid

A protein-rich fibrillar material with a characteristic cross-beta-sheet structure. Pathologic amyloid deposits can accumulate in tissues, disrupt organ function, and cause amyloidosis.

Alternate Names:
Amyloid Protein

Amyloid Nephropathy

Renal involvement occurring in systemic amyloidosis, characterized by extracellular accumulation of insoluble amyloid fibrils in glomerular, vascular, and interstitial compartments, typically leading to heavy proteinuria, nephrotic syndrome, and progressive kidney failure.

Amyloid Neuropathy

Nerve damage caused by amyloid deposits in or around peripheral nerves. It may cause numbness, tingling, burning pain, weakness, or problems with automatic body functions such as blood-pressure control.

Amyloidosis

A group of diseases in which proteins fold abnormally, clump together, and form deposits called amyloid in tissues or organs. Amyloidosis may be localized to one site or systemic, affecting several organs such as the kidneys, heart, liver, nerves, or digestive tract. Major forms include light-chain (AL), serum amyloid A (AA), and transthyretin (ATTR) amyloidosis; effects vary with the amyloid protein and organs involved.

Alternate Names:
Amyloid Disease; Amyloid Infiltration

Amyloid PET

A brain scan using a small radioactive tracer that attaches to amyloid deposits. It can help assess selected cognitive disorders, but a positive scan does not by itself establish a specific dementia diagnosis.

Amyloid Plaque

A deposit of amyloid-beta protein outside nerve cells in the brain. Plaques are associated with Alzheimer disease, but their presence alone does not explain

every person's memory or thinking problem.

Amyloid Precursor Protein

A normal protein found in nerve-cell membranes. Enzymes can cut it into smaller pieces, including amyloid-beta; abnormal accumulation of amyloid-beta in the brain is associated with Alzheimer disease.

Alternate Names:
APP; Amyloid-Beta Precursor Protein

Amyloid Purpura

Purple or bruise-like spots, often around the eyes, caused by amyloid deposits weakening small blood vessels. It may occur with systemic amyloidosis and can be accompanied by easy bruising elsewhere.

Amyoplasia

The most common form of arthrogryposis multiplex congenita, characterized by the congenital absence or marked underdevelopment of skeletal muscle tissue, resulting in symmetric multiple joint contractures and replacement of muscle tissue with fibrous and fatty material.

Alternate Names:
Classic Arthrogryposis; Amyoplasia Congenita

Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis

A progressive disease that damages nerve cells in the brain and spinal cord that control voluntary muscle movement and breathing. It causes increasing muscle weakness, muscle wasting, twitching, and stiffness, which can make walking, speaking, swallowing, and breathing difficult. Sensation usually remains normal, though some people have changes in thinking or behavior. Most cases occur without a known family cause; some are inherited.

Alternate Names:
Lou Gehrig's Disease ALS

Anabolic Steroid Induced Hypogonadism

Reduced testicular hormone production and fertility caused by misuse of anabolic steroids. Extra steroid hormones suppress the body's normal hormone signals and may lead to testicular shrinkage, low sex drive, erectile problems, infertility, or depression.

Alternate Names:
ASIH; Anabolic-Androgenic Steroid-Induced Hypogonadism

Anabolic Steroids

Synthetic medicines related to testosterone that promote muscle and bone growth. They have limited medical uses but are sometimes misused for appearance or performance; misuse can harm the heart, liver, fertility, mood, and hormone system.

Anabolic Steroid Use and Abuse

Use of anabolic-androgenic steroids without a medical indication or at excessive doses. It can suppress natural hormone production and affect fertility, mood, blood pressure, cholesterol, liver function, heart structure, and growth in adolescents.

Anabolism

The set of body processes that use energy to build larger molecules from smaller ones, such as making proteins from amino acids or storing glucose as glycogen.

Anaemia

A condition in which the blood has too few red blood cells or too little haemoglobin. This reduces the blood's ability to carry oxygen and may cause tiredness, weakness, breathlessness, or dizziness.

Anaerobe

A microorganism that can grow without oxygen. Some anaerobes are harmed or killed by oxygen, while others tolerate oxygen but do not use it to produce energy.

Anaerobic

Able to live, grow, or function without oxygen. Anaerobic bacteria can cause infections in deep wounds, abscesses, the mouth, abdomen, or pelvis.

Anaerobic Bacteria

Bacteria that can grow without oxygen. Obligate anaerobes cannot use oxygen and may be harmed by it, while facultative anaerobes can grow with

or without oxygen. Anaerobic bacteria normally live in places such as the mouth, intestine, and vagina. They can cause infections in deep wounds, abscesses, the abdomen, pelvis, or other tissues with low oxygen.

Anaerobic Glycolysis

The metabolic breakdown of glucose into lactate in the absence or insufficiency of cellular oxygen, producing a net yield of two molecules of adenosine triphosphate per glucose molecule and regenerating oxidized nicotinamide adenine dinucleotide (NAD+) to maintain energy generation.

Anagen

The active growth phase of the hair cycle, when cells in the hair root make the hair shaft. Scalp hairs usually remain in this phase for several years before entering a resting or shedding phase.

Anagen Effluvium

An abrupt, extensive shedding of hair during the active growth (anagen) phase, caused by acute toxic disruption of mitotic activity in the follicular matrix cells. It typically begins within days to weeks of exposure to cytotoxic chemotherapy, ionizing radiation, or acute heavy metal poisoning.

Anal Abscess

A collection of pus near or within the anus, usually caused by an infected anal gland. It can cause throbbing pain, swelling, fever, and difficulty sitting.

Anal Canal

The final part of the digestive tract, extending from the rectum to the anus. It contains muscles that control the passage of stool and has different nerve and blood supplies along its length.

Anal Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the anal canal or perianal skin. Most are squamous cell carcinomas, usually associated with oncogenic human papillomavirus (HPV) infection. Symptoms may include anal bleeding, pain, a lump, itching, discharge, or a change in bowel habits; diagnosis is confirmed by examination and biopsy.

Anal Carcinoma

Alternate term; see *Anal Cancer*.

Anal Condyloma

A wart-like growth on or around the anus, usually caused by low-risk types of human papillomavirus. It is usually not cancerous, but multiple or recurring warts may occur with other abnormal anal cells.

Anal Dysplasia

Abnormal, precancerous cellular alterations within the squamous epithelium lining the anal canal, most commonly induced by persistent infection with high-risk oncogenic human papillomaviruses (HPV).

Alternate Names:
Anal Intraepithelial Neoplasia; AIN

Anal Fissure

A linear tear in the lining of the anal canal, often following passage of hard stool or repeated diarrhea. It typically causes sharp pain during defecation that may persist afterward, sometimes with a small amount of bright-red blood on wiping.

Anal Fistula

An epithelialized tract connecting the anal canal with the perianal skin, most often developing after infection of an anal gland or an abscess. It may cause persistent or intermittent drainage, discomfort, or recurrent abscesses. Crohn disease is another important cause.

Analgesia

Relief or absence of pain without necessarily causing unconsciousness. It may result from medicines, a nerve block, or another treatment; touch, pressure, or movement may still be felt.

Analgesics

Medicines that reduce or relieve pain. Non-opioid analgesics reduce pain and fever. Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs) reduce pain, fever, and inflammation by lowering the production of

substances involved in these responses. Opioid analgesics reduce the brain's and spinal cord's response to pain but may cause sleepiness, constipation, slowed breathing, tolerance, and dependence. Adjuvant analgesics are medicines mainly used for other conditions that can help with certain types of pain, such as nerve pain. The choice depends on the type and severity of pain, the person's health, and possible risks.

Alternate Names:
Painkillers; Pain-Relieving Medicines

Anal Herpes

A viral infection of the perianal skin and anal canal caused by herpes simplex virus (usually HSV-2 or HSV-1), characterized by painful, grouped fluid-filled vesicles that rupture into shallow ulcerations accompanied by local pain, itching, and tenesmus.

Alternate Names:
Perianal Herpes; Anorectal Herpes

Anal Intercourse

Sexual activity involving insertion into the anus. Because the anal lining can tear and does not provide natural lubrication, it can transmit infections and cause injury if precautions are not used.

Anal Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Abnormal cells in the lining of the anus, usually associated with persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection. Low-grade changes may resolve, while high-grade changes can progress to anal cancer.

Anal Itching

Itching of the skin around the anus (pruritus ani), which may have no identified cause or result from moisture or stool seepage, irritation, dermatitis, hemorrhoids, fissures, or infection. Pinworms are a possible cause, particularly in children.

Alternate Names:
Perianal Itching; Rectal Itching

Anal Mucositis

Inflammation and open sores of the anal lining, often caused by radiation or chemotherapy. It can cause pain, burning, bleeding, discharge, and difficulty passing stool.

Anal Necrosis

Death of tissue around the anus, anal canal, or nearby skin. It may result from severe infection, poor blood flow, injury, or radiation and can cause severe pain, skin discolouration, blisters, fever, or rapid worsening.

Analog

A substance, structure, or process that resembles another and has a similar function but is not identical in chemical makeup or structure.

Analogous

Similar in function or purpose to another structure or process, even though its origin or physical structure is different.

Anal Pain

Pain around the anus or nearby skin. Common causes include a fissure, abscess, thrombosed haemorrhoid, muscle spasm, infection, or inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Proctalgia

Anal Papilla

A small, usually normal projection of the anal lining near the junction between the upper and lower types of lining in the anal canal.

Anal Sphincter

A muscular structure that controls passage of stool and gas from the anal canal. It includes the involuntary internal anal sphincter and the voluntary external anal sphincter.

Anal Stenosis

Abnormal narrowing of the anal canal that impedes the normal passage of stool, usually resulting from scarring following surgical procedures such as hemorrhoidectomy, or from chronic inflammatory bowel disease, trauma, or radiation therapy.

Alternate Names:

Anal Stricture

Anal Warts

Benign fleshy growths or lesions occurring on the perianal skin or within the anal canal, caused by localized infection with low-risk strains of the human papillomavirus, particularly types 6 and 11.

Alternate Names:
Condylomata Acuminata of Anus; Perianal Warts

Anal Yeast Infection

A localized superficial fungal infection of the perianal skin caused by overgrowth of *Candida* species, primarily *Candida albicans*, causing intense pruritus, redness, maceration, and burning around the anus.

Alternate Names:
Perianal Candidiasis; Anal Thrush

Analysis

A careful examination of information, samples, measurements, symptoms, or clinical problems to identify patterns, understand causes, or support a medical decision.

Analysis Of Urine

Laboratory examination of urine for blood, cells, protein, glucose, germs, and other substances. Results can help assess urinary infection, kidney disease, diabetes, bleeding, dehydration, and other conditions.

Analytic Sensitivity

The smallest amount of a substance that a laboratory method can reliably detect. It describes the test's measurement ability and is different from clinical sensitivity, which describes how well a test detects disease.

Anaphia

Complete loss of touch sensation in a body area. It may result from nerve injury, neurological disease, reduced blood flow, or anaesthetic treatment and can allow burns, wounds, or pressure injuries to go unnoticed.

Alternate Names:
Anaptic

Anaphylactic Shock

A severe form of anaphylaxis in which a sudden allergic reaction causes dangerously low blood pressure and poor blood flow to organs. It may occur with airway swelling, breathing difficulty, collapse, or cardiac arrest.

Anaphylactoid Reaction

An older term for a reaction resembling anaphylaxis that is not caused by an IgE-mediated allergy. Current terminology generally uses non-IgE-mediated or nonimmune anaphylaxis, depending on the mechanism.

Alternate Names:
Non-Allergic Anaphylaxis; Pseudoallergic Reaction

Anaphylatoxin

A small peptide fragment (predominantly C3a, C4a, and C5a) generated during activation of the complement cascade. Anaphylatoxins induce mast cell degranulation, smooth muscle contraction, increased vascular permeability, and chemotaxis of phagocytic leukocytes.

Anaphylaxis

A rapidly developing, potentially life-threatening systemic hypersensitivity reaction characterized by compromise of the airway, breathing, or circulation, often accompanied by mucosal or skin manifestations (such as urticaria, angioedema, or flushing) and gastrointestinal symptoms. Prompt administration of intramuscular epinephrine (adrenaline) into the anterolateral thigh is the definitive first-line emergency treatment. Anaphylaxis may occur without circulatory shock, and skin signs may occasionally be absent.

Anaphylaxis During Anesthesia

A severe allergic reaction occurring during or soon after anaesthesia. It may cause sudden low blood pressure, airway narrowing, breathing difficulty, collapse, or skin flushing; triggers can include medicines, antiseptics, or latex.

Anaplasia

Loss of the normal mature features and specialized function of cells. Anaplastic cells may vary greatly in size and shape, have abnormal nuclei, and divide rapidly or unusually. Anaplasia is most often seen in high-grade cancers and usually suggests more aggressive behavior. It is different from metaplasia, in which one mature cell type changes into another cell type.

Anaplasmosis

A tick-borne infection caused by the bacterium *Anaplasma phagocytophilum*. It may cause fever, headache, muscle aches, low platelet and white-cell counts, and raised liver enzymes. PCR or paired blood-antibody tests can help confirm it. Morulae seen in white blood cells can support the diagnosis but are not always present and do not confirm it alone.

Alternate Names:
Human Granulocytic Anaplasmosis; HGA

Anaplastic

Describing cells or a tumor that has lost many features of its normal mature form. Anaplastic tumors often grow quickly, invade nearby tissue, or spread, although the outlook depends on the specific cancer and its treatment.

Anaplastic Astrocytoma

An older term for a high-grade tumour arising from star-shaped supporting cells in the brain. Modern classification relies on its genetic features as well as its appearance; symptoms depend on its location.

Anaplastic Ependymoma

A high-grade tumour arising from cells lining the brain's fluid-filled spaces or the spinal canal. It can grow quickly and may obstruct the flow of cerebrospinal fluid.

Anaplastic Large Cell Lymphoma

A rare type of non-Hodgkin lymphoma arising from abnormal T cells. The cells are usually large and carry the CD30 marker; the disease may affect the skin, lymph nodes, or other organs.

Alternate Names:
ALCL

Anaplastic Large-cell Lymphoma

Alternate spelling; see *Anaplastic Large Cell Lymphoma*.

Anaplastic Thyroid Cancer

Alternate name; see *Anaplastic Thyroid Carcinoma*.

Anaplastic Thyroid Carcinoma

An extremely aggressive, undifferentiated malignancy of the thyroid follicular epithelium characterized by rapid local invasion into adjacent cervical structures and early distant metastasis. Presenting symptoms include a rapidly enlarging hard neck mass, hoarseness, dysphagia, and dyspnea, carrying a very poor median survival despite multimodality therapy.

Alternate Names:
Undifferentiated Thyroid Carcinoma; ATC

Anarithmetia

A primary neuropsychological impairment in basic arithmetic reasoning, computational ability, and understanding of numerical concepts, distinguishing it from secondary calculation deficits caused by spatial or linguistic impairments. It is typically associated with lesions of the dominant inferior parietal lobule (angular gyrus).

Anasarca

Severe, widespread swelling caused by excess fluid under the skin and sometimes around organs. It can occur with serious heart, kidney, or liver disease or very low blood protein and may cause rapid weight gain or breathing difficulty.

Anastomosis

A surgical, traumatic, or pathological connection created between two hollow organs, tubular structures, or blood vessels (such as an arterial anastomosis, arterio-venous fistula, or bowel resection re-connection), establishing communication and allowing continuous fluid or luminal flow.

Anastomotic Leak

Leakage from a connection made during surgery, often where two sections of intestine or another hollow organ were joined. An incomplete seal can allow contents into nearby tissue and cause pain, fever, infection, or life-threatening illness.

Anastrozole

A medicine that lowers the body's production of oestrogen. It is used mainly for hormone-sensitive breast cancer, especially after menopause.

Anatomical Axis

An imaginary line around which a body part rotates or moves. Anatomical axes help describe movements such as rotation of the shoulder, hip, spine, or other joints.

Anatomical Conduit

A natural or surgically created passage that carries air, fluid, tissue, or another structure between body regions, such as an airway, blood vessel, or surgical channel.

Anatomical Orifice

A natural opening into or out of the body or through a body structure, such as the mouth, nostril, anus, urethra, or an opening of a blood vessel.

Alternate Names:
Body Opening

Anatomical Planes

Imaginary flat surfaces used to divide the body into sections for describing anatomy and interpreting medical scans. Common planes are sagittal, coronal, and transverse.

Anatomical Position

The standard reference posture for describing the body: standing upright, facing forward, arms at the sides, hands turned forward, and feet directed forward.

Anatomical Snuffbox

A triangular hollow on the thumb side of the back of the wrist that appears when the thumb is extended. It overlies the scaphoid bone and radial artery; tenderness there after a fall may indicate a scaphoid fracture.

Alternate Names:
Anatomic Snuffbox

Anatomic Orientation Terms

Standard words used to describe the position of one body structure relative to another, including above, below, front, back, near, far, inside, and outside.

Anatomist

A scientist or health professional who studies the structure of the human or animal body, including its organs, tissues, blood vessels, nerves, and their relationships.

Anatomy

The study of body structure and how its parts relate to one another. It includes visible structures, tissues and cells seen with magnification, and how the body develops.

ANCA-Associated Vasculitis

A group of rare diseases in which the immune system attacks small blood vessels. It can affect the kidneys, lungs, nerves, skin, eyes, and other organs. A blood test for antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibodies (ANCA) can help with diagnosis but cannot confirm the disease on its own.

Ancillary Pathology Studies

Supplementary diagnostic modalities—including immunohistochemistry, special histochemical stains, flow cytometry, in situ hybridization, and molecular genetic assays—performed in conjunction with standard light microscopy to achieve precise pathological classification.

Ancylostomiasis

A parasitic nematode infection caused by species of the genus *Ancylostoma* (such as *Ancylostoma duodenale*), acquired through transcutaneous penetration of infective larvae from contaminated soil, characteristically leading to chronic intestinal blood

loss, iron deficiency anemia, and hypoproteinemia.

Alternate Names:
Hookworm Infection

Andersen-Tawil Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder with a variable combination of episodic flaccid muscle weakness (periodic paralysis), ventricular arrhythmias, and distinctive facial or skeletal features. Cardiac findings may include prominent U waves and prolonged QT or QU intervals; not every affected person has the full triad.

Alternate Names:
ATS; Periodic Paralysis Type 3; Andersen Syndrome

Anderson Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which abnormal glycogen builds up in cells because of changes in the *GBE1* gene. It usually begins in infancy with poor growth and an enlarged liver and may progress to scarring, high blood pressure in the liver, and liver failure.

Alternate Names:
Glycogen Storage Disease Type IV (GSD IV); Amylopectinosis

Androgen

A hormone such as testosterone that helps regulate sexual development, fertility, muscle, bone, and hair growth in people of all sexes.

Androgen Deficiency

Too little production or effect of androgen hormones, especially testosterone. In males, it may cause reduced sexual desire, erectile difficulty, infertility, loss of muscle or bone, low energy, or reduced facial and body hair.

Androgenetic Alopecia

A common, inherited form of gradual hair loss caused by sensitivity of hair follicles to androgen hormones. It usually produces a receding hairline or crown thinning in males and diffuse thinning over the crown in females.

Androgen Excess

Abnormally high levels or effects of androgen hormones. It may cause acne, increased facial or body hair, scalp hair loss, irregular periods, infertility, or a deeper voice, especially in females.

Alternate Names:
Hyperandrogenism

Androgenic

Relating to androgen hormones, such as testosterone, or producing their effects. These effects may include facial or body hair, oily skin, a deeper voice, muscle growth, and development of male reproductive features.

Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome

An inherited condition in which cells cannot respond fully to testosterone and related hormones. A person with XY chromosomes may therefore have female-appearing external genitals, incomplete male development, undescended testes, and no uterus.

Androgen Insufficiency

A level or effect of androgen hormones that is too low for normal body function. Symptoms may include reduced sexual desire, erectile difficulty, infertility, low energy, reduced muscle mass, or weaker bones.

Alternate Names:
Androgen Deficiency

Androgen Receptor

A protein in cells that binds testosterone and related hormones. This allows the hormones to influence sexual development, reproduction, muscle, bones, hair, and some cancers.

Androgen Suppression

Lowering the production of androgen hormones or blocking their action in the body. It is used mainly for some hormone-sensitive cancers, especially prostate cancer, and can cause hot flushes, sexual problems, bone loss, weight change, and metabolic effects.

Alternate Names:
Androgen Deprivation

Android Pelvis

A relatively narrow, heart-shaped or funnel-shaped female pelvis with reduced space in the middle. During childbirth, this shape may make passage of the baby more difficult than some other pelvic shapes.

Andropause

Alternate informal term; see *Male Hypogonadism*.

Androphobia

An irrational and overwhelming fear of men, leading to high levels of anxiety, psychological distress, and deliberate avoidance of male individuals.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Men

Anejaculation

Inability to release semen during orgasm or sexual activity. It may result from nerve or spinal disease, pelvic surgery, medicines, diabetes, hormonal problems, or psychological factors and may cause infertility.

Anembryonic Pregnancy

An early pregnancy loss in which a gestational sac and trophoblastic tissue implant and grow within the uterus, but an embryo fails to develop; medically termed a blighted ovum.

Anemia

A lower-than-normal haemoglobin concentration in the blood. It may reduce oxygen delivery to tissues and cause tiredness, weakness, shortness of breath, or dizziness, though mild anemia may cause no symptoms. Causes include blood loss, reduced red-cell production, or increased red-cell breakdown.

Alternate Names:
Anaemia

Anemia and Thrombocytopenia in Pregnancy

Low red-cell or platelet counts during pregnancy. Causes include iron deficiency, normal blood-volume changes, other nutritional deficiencies, immune or hypertensive disorders, bleeding, infection, and bone-marrow disease.

Anemia in Newborns

A reduction in red blood cell volume or hemoglobin concentration in an infant during the first 28 days of life, arising from blood loss (such as fetomaternal hemorrhage), hemolysis (such as ABO or Rh incompatibility), or decreased red-cell production.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Anemia

Anemia In Pregnancy

Anemia during pregnancy, commonly caused by iron deficiency, folate deficiency, vitamin B12 deficiency, blood loss, or the normal increase in the liquid part of blood. It can cause tiredness, weakness, breathlessness, or dizziness.

Alternate Names:
Gestational Anemia; Pregnancy-Associated Anemia

Anemia Of Chronic Disease

Anemia associated with long-term inflammation, infection, cancer, kidney disease, or another chronic illness. Inflammation limits the use of stored iron and reduces red-cell production; mild cases may cause no symptoms.

Anemia Of Inflammation

Anemia caused by long-lasting infection, inflammatory disease, cancer, or another condition that activates the immune system. Inflammation traps iron in storage and slows red-cell production.

Anemia of Malignancy

A multifactorial normocytic or microcytic anemia developing in patients with neoplastic disease, resulting from cytokine-mediated blunting of erythropoiesis, impaired iron utilization, marrow infiltration, hemorrhage, or myelosuppressive antineoplastic therapies.

Alternate Names:
Cancer-Related Anemia; Anemia of Cancer

Anemic

Having anemia, meaning that the blood carries less

oxygen than the body needs because it has too few red blood cells or too little haemoglobin.

Anencephalic

Relating to or affected by anencephaly, a neural tube defect in which major portions of the brain and skull fail to develop. The adjective is usually applied to an embryo, fetus, or newborn with this condition. Anencephaly arises when the upper neural tube fails to close during early embryonic development.

Anencephaly

A severe neural tube defect in which the cranial end of the neural tube fails to close during early embryonic development, preventing normal formation of much of the brain and skull. The forebrain and cerebrum are absent or severely underdeveloped, although some lower brain structures may remain. Many affected pregnancies end in stillbirth; infants born alive usually die within hours or days. The condition is often identified before birth.

Anergy

A state in which an immune cell does not respond to a substance that would normally activate it. The cell remains present but is functionally quiet; this can help prevent attacks against the body's own tissues.

Anesthesia

A medically controlled loss of feeling caused by medicines during a procedure. Anesthetic medicines mainly block nerve signals, especially pain signals, from reaching the brain. Local anesthesia numbs a small area while the person remains awake. Regional anesthesia blocks nerves supplying a larger part of the body and may be used while the person remains awake. General anesthesia also changes brain activity to cause controlled unconsciousness. Before modern anesthesia, surgery was extremely painful and had to be very quick; anesthesia made longer and more complex operations possible. Breathing, blood pressure, heart rate, and oxygen levels are monitored.

Alternate Names:
Anaesthesia

Anesthesia Gas Analyzers

Devices that measure the amounts of oxygen, carbon dioxide, and inhaled anesthetic gases delivered to and breathed out by a patient during anesthesia. They help detect problems with breathing or gas delivery.

Anesthesia Informatics

The use of electronic records, monitoring data, and computer systems to support anesthesia care. It can improve documentation, identify medicine interactions or dosing errors, and help evaluate outcomes.

Anesthesia Machine

Equipment that supplies controlled mixtures of oxygen, air, and anesthetic gases, and supports breathing during anesthesia. It includes systems that remove carbon dioxide and safety devices that warn of delivery problems.

Anesthesia Monitoring

Continuous assessment of vital functions during anesthesia, including oxygen levels, breathing, blood pressure, heart rate, temperature, and level of unconsciousness as appropriate for the procedure.

Anesthesia Pharmacogenomics

The study of how inherited genetic differences affect responses to anesthetic and pain medicines. Examples include prolonged muscle paralysis from pseudocholinesterase deficiency and inherited susceptibility to malignant hyperthermia.

Anesthesiologist

A doctor trained to provide anesthesia and manage pain, breathing, blood pressure, and other vital functions during procedures. Anesthesiologists also assess patients before surgery and may treat critical illness or severe pain.

Anesthesiology

The medical specialty concerned with anesthesia and perioperative care. Anesthesiologists assess and support patients before, during, and after procedures, managing consciousness, pain, and vital functions such as breathing and circulation. The

field also includes critical care and pain medicine.

Alternate Names:
Anaesthesiology

Anetoderma

A rare disorder caused by loss or weakening of elastic fibers in the dermis, producing soft, wrinkled, depressed, or pouch-like macules and plaques with a characteristic button-hole feel. It may be primary or follow infection, inflammation, autoimmune disease, or another skin lesion; biopsy and selected systemic evaluation may be needed.

Aneuploidy

An abnormal number of whole chromosomes in a cell, caused by an error during cell division. A cell may have an extra or missing chromosome, as in trisomy 21, and this can affect development or pregnancy.

Aneurysm

An abnormal bulge or widening in an artery caused by weakness in its wall. Many aneurysms cause no symptoms. Depending on their location and size, they may enlarge, press on nearby structures, or rupture and cause serious bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Aneurysms

Aneurysmal Bone Cyst

A benign but locally aggressive osteolytic bone lesion composed of multiple blood-filled, communicating fibrous cavities that expand and thin the surrounding cortical bone, most commonly developing in the metaphysis of long bones or the posterior spine in children and adolescents.

Alternate Names:
ABC

Aneurysm Clip

A small surgical device placed across the opening of a brain aneurysm to stop blood from entering it. It is usually placed during open brain surgery; rarely, it may move, block a nearby vessel, or allow bleeding to recur.

Aneurysm Clipping

Brain surgery to place a small clip across the opening of a brain aneurysm, a weak bulge in a brain artery. The clip stops blood from entering the bulge and lowers the risk of bleeding, but the procedure has its own risks and cannot guarantee that a stroke or future bleeding will not occur.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Clipping; Cerebral Aneurysm Clipping; Microvascular Clipping

Aneurysm Coils

Soft metal coils placed inside an aneurysm through a catheter. The coils promote clotting within the bulge and reduce blood flow into it, lowering the chance of rupture.

Aneurysm Repair

A procedure that reinforces, closes, or replaces a weakened section of a blood vessel to prevent rupture or other complications. It may be performed through open surgery or through a catheter inside the vessel.

Angelman Syndrome

A genetic disorder affecting brain development and function, usually because the maternal copy of the *UBE3A* gene is missing or inactive. It causes severe developmental delay, very limited speech, movement and balance problems, seizures, and a characteristic happy or excitable manner.

Anger

An emotional response to frustration, unfairness, danger, or a perceived threat. It may range from irritation to intense rage; persistent or uncontrollable anger can affect relationships, safety, and health.

Angiitis

Inflammation of blood-vessel walls, also called vasculitis. Depending on the vessel and disease type, inflammation may narrow or block the vessel, reduce blood flow, weaken its wall, or cause bleeding. Necrosis may occur in some forms but is not required for the term.

Alternate Names:

Vasculitis; Blood Vessel Inflammation; Arteritis

Angina

Chest discomfort that occurs when the heart muscle does not get enough oxygen-rich blood, usually because of coronary artery disease, but sometimes because of spasm or problems in the heart's small blood vessels. It may feel like pressure, squeezing, tightness, burning, or indigestion and may spread to the arm, jaw, neck, shoulder, or back. Breathlessness, nausea, sweating, or unusual tiredness may occur, sometimes without chest pain. Stable angina usually follows a predictable pattern, often with activity, and may improve with rest. New, worsening, prolonged, or rest symptoms can indicate unstable angina or a heart attack.

Alternate Names:
Angina Pectoris

Angina Bullosa Hemorrhagica

A usually benign, sudden blood-filled blister of the oral mucosa, most often the soft palate. It may follow minor trauma, inhaled or topical steroids, or occur with diabetes; blisters usually rupture and heal spontaneously. Recurrent or atypical lesions can resemble autoimmune blistering disease.

Angina Symptoms

Symptoms of reduced blood flow to the heart may include pressure, squeezing, burning, or tightness in the chest, with discomfort spreading to the arm, jaw, back, or shoulder. Breathlessness, sweating, nausea, or unusual tiredness may also occur.

Alternate Names:
Ischemic Chest Pain; Anginal Chest Pain; Anginal Discomfort

Anginophobia

An extreme, irrational fear of experiencing angina pectoris, heart attacks, or sudden chest pain, causing chronic anxiety and frequent emergency-department visits.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Chest Pain

Angioblastoma

A usually slow-growing, highly vascular tumour of the central nervous system, most often found in the cerebellum or spinal cord. It may cause headache, balance problems, weakness, or other symptoms from pressure on nearby tissue.

Angiocardiography

Imaging of the heart and major blood vessels, usually after contrast material is given. X-ray, CT, or MRI can show the heart chambers, valves, narrowed vessels, leaks, abnormal connections, or other structural problems.

Angiodysplasia

A common acquired vascular malformation characterized by fragile, dilated, tortuous submucosal blood vessels in the gastrointestinal tract, most frequently found in the cecum and right colon of adults over age 60. It is a major cause of recurrent, painless lower gastrointestinal bleeding and unexplained iron-deficiency anemia. It is strongly associated with aortic valve stenosis (Heyde's syndrome, due to acquired von Willebrand factor deficiency) and chronic renal failure. Diagnosis is established on colonoscopy, where lesions appear as small, bright-red, spider-like mucosal patches; active or high-risk bleeding is treated endoscopically using argon plasma coagulation (APC) or electrocautery.

Alternate Names:
Colonic Angiodysplasia; Arteriovenous Malformation of the Colon; Vascular Ectasia of the Colon

Angiodysplasia of Gastrointestinal Tract

A common vascular anomaly of the gastrointestinal mucosa characterized by dilated, tortuous, and fragile submucosal capillaries and venules, most commonly located in the cecum and ascending colon, and representing a frequent cause of lower gastrointestinal bleeding in older adults.

Alternate Names:
GI Angiodysplasia

Angiodysplasia Of The Colon

Alternate name; see *Angiodysplasia*.

Angioedema

Sudden swelling in the deeper layers of the skin or in moist tissues inside the body. It often affects the lips, eyelids, tongue, throat, hands, feet, or gut. Some types occur with itchy hives, while others usually do not. Swelling of the tongue or throat can block breathing.

Angioedema And Hives

Alternate name; see *Urticaria And Angioedema*.

Angiofibroma

A usually noncancerous growth made of blood vessels and fibrous tissue. It commonly appears as a small facial papule in adolescents or, in a different form, as a vascular tumour in the back of the nose that may cause blockage or nosebleeds.

Angiofollicular Lymph Node Hyperplasia

An uncommon disorder in which lymph nodes contain excess small blood vessels and abnormal immune-cell growth. Castleman disease may affect one lymph-node region or many parts of the body.

Alternate Names:
Castleman Disease

Angiogenesis

The formation of new blood vessels from existing vessels. It is normal during growth, menstruation, and wound healing, but abnormal angiogenesis can help cancers grow and can damage vision in some eye diseases.

Angiogenesis Inhibition

Preventing or slowing the growth of new blood vessels. This can limit a tumor's blood supply or reduce harmful vessel growth in some eye diseases. Treatment may increase the risk of high blood pressure, bleeding, or delayed wound healing.

Alternate Names:
Antiangiogenic Therapy

Angiogenesis Inhibitor

A therapeutic agent that inhibits the formation of new blood vessels, predominantly by antagonizing vascular endothelial growth factor (VEGF) or its receptors, used in oncology to restrict tumor blood supply and in ophthalmology to treat neovascular macular degeneration.

Alternate Names:
Antiangiogenic Agent

Angiogram

An image of blood vessels, usually made after contrast material is given. It can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, tearing, abnormal connections, or bleeding and may be produced by catheter X-ray, computed tomography, or magnetic resonance imaging.

Angiography

Imaging of blood vessels to show their shape and blood flow. It may use X-rays with injected contrast material, computed tomography (CT), magnetic resonance imaging (MRI), or a catheter placed inside a blood vessel. Angiography can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysms, abnormal connections, bleeding, or other vascular abnormalities; catheter angiography may also allow treatment during the same procedure.

Angioid Streak

Irregular dark lines caused by breaks in a tough layer beneath the retina. They may bleed or allow abnormal blood vessels to grow, reducing vision, and can be associated with some inherited disorders.

Angioimmunoblastic T-Cell Lymphoma

An aggressive subtype of peripheral mature T-cell lymphoma characterized by generalized lymphadenopathy, constitutional symptoms (fever, night sweats, weight loss), hepatosplenomegaly, skin rashes, and polyclonal hypergammaglobulinemia.

Alternate Names:
AITL

Angiokeratoma

A benign cutaneous vascular lesion characterized by ectatic, dilated blood vessels in the upper dermis associated with overlying epidermal hyperkeratosis, presenting as dark red, blue, or purple scaly papules.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Angiokeratoma

Angiokeratoma of the Scrotum

A benign vascular papule caused by superficial capillary dilation and overlying thickened skin, usually appearing as multiple dark-red, blue, or purple papules on the scrotum. Lesions may bleed after friction and can be mistaken for melanoma or other lesions; examination establishes the diagnosis.

Angiolipoma

A common benign subcutaneous tumor composed of mature adipose tissue interspersed with a network of proliferating capillary blood vessels, typically presenting as multiple tender, mobile nodules on the forearms of young adults.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Lipoma

Angiolymphoid Hyperplasia With Eosinophilia

An uncommon benign vascular and inflammatory lesion, also called epithelioid hemangioma, that produces solitary or grouped red-brown papules or nodules, usually on the head and neck near the ears or scalp. Eosinophilia may occur; biopsy distinguishes it from Kimura disease and other vascular or neoplastic lesions.

Alternate Names:
Epithelioid Hemangioma

Angiomatoid Fibrous Histiocytoma

A rare soft-tissue neoplasm of intermediate biological potential, primarily affecting children and young adults, characterized microscopically by sheets of histiocyte-like cells surrounding pseudo-vascular, blood-filled cystic spaces and a fibrous pseudocapsule.

Alternate Names:
AFH

Angiomyofibroblastoma

A usually noncancerous, slow-growing tumour of blood-vessel and connective-tissue cells, most often occurring as a small, well-defined, painless mass in the vulva or vagina.

Angiomyolipoma

A usually noncancerous kidney tumour made of blood vessels, muscle, and fat. It may occur alone or with tuberous sclerosis and can bleed, especially when large.

Angio-Oedema

British spelling; see *Angioedema*.

Angiopathy

Any disease or abnormal change in blood vessels. Causes include diabetes, inflammation, fatty deposits, injury, infection, and inherited disorders; effects depend on the vessels and organs involved.

Angioplasty

A catheter procedure used to widen a narrowed or blocked blood vessel, most often an artery. A catheter with a small, deflated balloon is guided to the narrowed area, usually with imaging. The balloon is inflated to widen the vessel, then deflated and removed. A stent may be placed to help keep the vessel open. Angioplasty is used in coronary and other arteries and, in some cases, veins.

Alternate Names:
Balloon Angioplasty; Percutaneous Transluminal Angioplasty

Angioplasty Balloon

An inflatable cylindrical balloon catheter designed to dilate stenotic vascular segments, fracture atheromatous plaques, or deploy and seat endovascular stents.

Alternate Names:
Balloon Catheter; Dilatation Balloon; Angioplasty Catheter

Angiosarcoma

A rare, fast-growing cancer that begins in cells lining blood or lymph vessels. It may occur in the skin, breast, liver, or bone and can spread to other organs.

Angiosarcoma Of The Breast

A rare cancer arising from cells that line blood vessels in the breast. It may arise there as a primary tumor or develop secondarily after radiation therapy or chronic lymphedema.

Angiosarcoma Of The Heart

A rare, aggressive cancer arising from blood-vessel cells in the heart, most often in the right upper chamber. It may obstruct blood flow, cause fluid around the heart or abnormal rhythms, and spread to other organs.

Angiotensin

A group of hormones that help regulate blood pressure and the body's salt and water balance. Angiotensin II narrows blood vessels and signals the kidneys and adrenal glands to retain salt and water.

Angiotensin Converting Enzyme

An enzyme that changes angiotensin I into angiotensin II, which raises blood pressure by narrowing blood vessels. The enzyme also breaks down bradykinin, a substance that can widen vessels.

Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme 2

A cell-surface zinc metalloprotease that cleaves angiotensin II into the vasodilatory and cardioprotective peptide angiotensin-(1-7), acting as an essential counter-regulatory enzyme within the renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system; also serves as the host cell receptor for the SARS-CoV-2 spike protein.

Alternate Names:
ACE2

Angiotensin I

A mostly inactive hormone made from angiotensinogen. Angiotensin-converting enzyme changes it into angiotensin II, which narrows blood vessels and promotes salt and water retention.

Angiotensin II

A hormone that narrows blood vessels and causes the body to retain salt and water. These effects increase blood pressure and help maintain blood flow when circulating volume is low.

Angiotensin Receptor Blockers

Medicines that prevent angiotensin II from activating its main receptor. They relax blood vessels and reduce salt and water retention, lowering blood pressure and reducing strain on the heart and kidneys.

Angle-Closure Glaucoma

A type of glaucoma in which the outer edge of the iris blocks the eye's drainage angle. Fluid then builds up, causing eye pressure to rise and potentially damaging the optic nerve and vision. It may develop suddenly with severe eye pain, blurred vision, halos, headache, nausea, or vomiting, or develop slowly without symptoms.

Angular Cheilitis

Soreness and cracking at one or both corners of the mouth. Moisture, yeast or bacterial infection, dentures, irritation, or low iron or vitamin levels can contribute.

Angular Stomatitis

Alternate name; see *Angular Cheilitis*.

Anhedonia

Reduced or absent ability to feel pleasure or interest in activities that were previously enjoyable. It can occur with depression, schizophrenia, substance use, and other conditions.

Anhidrosis

Failure to sweat when the body needs to cool itself. It may result from nerve or sweat-gland damage, skin disease, dehydration, medicines, or an inherited condition. Without enough sweat, the body can overheat.

Anhidrotic Asthenia

Older name for anhidrotic heat exhaustion, a rare heat-related illness linked to widespread miliaria (heat rash) and reduced sweating; see *Anhidrotic Heat Exhaustion*.

Anhidrotic Heat Exhaustion

A rare heat-related illness described after prolonged exposure to hot, humid conditions. Widespread miliaria (heat rash) blocks sweat ducts, reducing sweating and making it harder for the body to cool. It can cause heat intolerance, severe tiredness, headache, or breathing difficulty.

Alternate Names:
Tropical Anhidrotic Asthenia (older term); Sweat-Retention Syndrome (older term); Thermogenic Anhidrosis (older term)

Animal-Assisted Therapy

A planned healthcare intervention in which a trained animal is used with a qualified professional to support goals such as improving mood, communication, movement, or participation. Infection exposure and animal allergy are relevant considerations.

Animal Bites

Injuries caused by the teeth of animals such as dogs, cats, or wild animals, which can produce puncture wounds, lacerations, crush injuries, and significant bacterial inoculation, such as with *Pasteurella multocida* or rabies virus.

Alternate Names:
Animal Bite Injuries

Anion

A particle with a negative electrical charge. Important anions in body fluids include chloride, bicarbonate, and phosphate, which help maintain fluid balance, electrical activity, and the blood's acid level.

Anion Gap

A calculated diagnostic parameter derived from serum electrolyte concentrations to detect unmeasured anions in the blood, calculated as $[Na^+] - ([Cl^-] + [HCO_3^-])$. The normal range is typically 8–12 mEq/L (varying with laboratory analyzers; decreases by roughly 2.5 mEq/L for every 1 g/dL decline in serum albumin). An elevated anion gap indicates high-anion-gap metabolic acidosis caused by accumulation of unmeasured organic acids (e.g., lactic acidosis, diabetic or alcoholic ketoacidosis, uremia, or toxic ingestions such as methanol, ethylene glycol, and salicylates).

Anion Gap Metabolic Acidosis

Metabolic acidosis with an increased anion gap, which suggests extra acids or other unmeasured substances in the blood. Causes include lactic acidosis, ketoacidosis, kidney failure, and some poisonings. The reference range varies by laboratory and albumin level.

Alternate Names:
AGMA; High Anion Gap Metabolic Acidosis

Aniridia

A congenital, bilateral, complete or partial absence of the iris, typically caused by mutations in the PAX6 gene. It is accompanied by photophobia, nystagmus, reduced visual acuity, foveal hypoplasia, and an increased risk of early-onset glaucoma and cataracts, and may occur as part of the WAGR syndrome.

Anisakiasis

A parasitic infection caused by larvae of anisakid nematodes, especially *Anisakis* and *Pseudoterranova*, acquired by eating raw or undercooked marine fish or squid. Larvae may invade the stomach or intestine, causing acute abdominal pain, nausea, or vomiting; intestinal infection can produce eosinophilic granulomatous inflammation. Allergic reactions to parasite antigens may also occur.

Aniseikonia

An ocular condition in which there is a significant perceived difference in the size or shape of the retinal images between the right and left eyes, often resulting from high anisometropia or refractive surgery, leading to difficulty with binocular fusion and depth perception.

Alternate Names:
Unequal Retinal Image Size

Anismus

Inappropriate, paradoxical contraction or failure of relaxation of the puborectalis muscle and external anal sphincter during attempted defecation, caus-

ing pelvic floor dysfunction and chronic functional constipation.

Alternate Names:
Pelvic Floor Dyssynergia; Paradoxical Puborectalis Contraction

Anisocoria

An unequal size of the pupils, the black centers of the eyes. In about 20% of healthy people, a slight difference is natural and harmless. When abnormal, it is caused by eye injury, certain eye drops, or nerve disorders that prevent a pupil from widening or shrinking normally. Doctors test how the pupils react in bright light and darkness to identify the underlying cause.

Anisocytosis

Greater-than-usual variation in the size of red blood cells. It is a laboratory finding rather than a disease and may occur with iron deficiency, vitamin deficiency, or other types of anemia.

Anisometropia

A difference in the focusing power of the two eyes. It can cause unequal image size, blurred vision, eyestrain, or reduced development of vision in one eye during childhood.

Anisopoikilocytosis

Variation in both the size and shape of red blood cells, identified on examination of a blood smear. It is a morphological finding rather than a diagnosis and may occur in several anaemias and other blood disorders, including iron-deficiency or megaloblastic anaemia and haemoglobin disorders. The pattern of cell changes and accompanying laboratory findings help determine its significance.

Ankle

The joint connecting the lower leg and foot. It is formed mainly by the tibia, fibula, and talus and allows the foot to move up and down while ligaments provide stability.

Ankle Arthroplasty

Surgical replacement of the ankle joint with an artificial joint, usually for severe painful arthritis. It aims to reduce pain while preserving movement; suitability depends on bone, alignment, activity, and surrounding-joint condition.

Ankle Arthroscopy

A procedure using a small camera and instruments inserted through small cuts around the ankle to diagnose or treat problems such as loose bone or cartilage, inflamed lining, or tissue impingement.

Ankle Bone

Any of the bones forming the ankle joint, chiefly the lower ends of the tibia and fibula and the upper part of the talus.

Ankle-Brachial Index

A comparison of blood pressure measured at the ankle with blood pressure measured at the arm. A low result may indicate narrowed leg arteries; a very high result may mean the arteries are too stiff to measure reliably.

Ankle Dislocation

Complete displacement of the ankle bones from their normal joint position, usually after a severe injury. It often occurs with a fracture or ligament injury and can damage blood vessels or nerves.

Alternate Names:
Dislocated Ankle; Talotibial Dislocation

Ankle-Foot Orthosis

A brace that supports the ankle and foot and controls alignment or movement during standing and walking. It may improve walking or prevent foot drop caused by weakness, spasticity, instability, or deformity.

Ankle Fracture

A break in one or more bones forming the ankle, usually the tibia, fibula, or talus. It may cause pain, swelling, bruising, and inability to bear weight; displaced or unstable fractures may damage nearby tissues.

Ankle Fractures

Plural form; see *Ankle Fracture*.

Ankle Joint

The hinge-like joint between the lower ends of the tibia and fibula and the talus. It mainly moves the foot upward and downward and is supported by surrounding ligaments.

Ankle Pain

Pain in or around the ankle, commonly caused by a sprain, fracture, tendon problem, arthritis, bursitis, or infection. Associated findings may include deformity, marked swelling, fever, numbness, or inability to bear weight.

Ankle Replacement

Surgery that replaces the damaged surfaces of the ankle joint with an artificial joint, usually for severe arthritis causing persistent pain and disability. It aims to reduce pain and preserve ankle movement.

Ankle Sprain

An injury in which one or more ankle ligaments are stretched or torn, most often on the outer side after the foot twists inward. Pain, swelling, bruising, and a feeling of instability may occur.

Ankle Swelling

Enlargement around the ankle caused by injury, inflammation, infection, vein or lymph problems, or general fluid retention. Sudden one-sided swelling with pain, warmth, fever, or breathlessness can occur with vascular or infectious disease.

Ankyloblepharon

Abnormal sticking or joining of the upper and lower eyelid edges. It may be present at birth or follow inflammation, burns, injury, or surgery and can partly block vision when severe.

Ankyloglossia

Alternate name; see *Tongue-Tie*.

Ankylose

To become stiff or unable to move at a joint, sometimes because scar tissue or bone joins the joint surfaces.

Ankylosing

Causing or involving progressive stiffness or loss of movement in a joint, sometimes because scar tissue or bone joins the joint surfaces.

Ankylosing Spondylitis

A long-term inflammatory disease that mainly affects the spine and the joints linking the lower spine to the pelvis. It often causes back or buttock pain and stiffness that is worse after rest and eases with movement. In severe cases, bones in the spine may grow together and limit movement. The eyes and other joints can also be affected.

Alternate Names:
Bekhterev Disease; Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis; Marie-Strümpell Disease

Ankylosis

Abnormal reduction or complete loss of movement in a joint. It may result from fibrous scar tissue, bone fusion, injury, infection, chronic inflammation, or surgery. Fibrous ankylosis involves scar tissue, while bony ankylosis involves fusion of neighboring bones. In dentistry, ankylosis may describe fusion of a tooth root to the surrounding jawbone.

Ankyrin

A protein that connects selected cell-surface proteins to the cell's internal support framework. It helps red blood cells keep their shape; inherited changes can make the cells fragile and cause anemia.

Annihilation

The conversion of a particle and its opposite partner into energy when they collide. In PET scanning, a positron meets an electron and produces two gamma rays that travel in opposite directions to create the image.

Annular Pancreas

A birth defect in which pancreatic tissue forms a ring around part of the duodenum, the first section of the small intestine. The ring may narrow the intestine and cause vomiting, abdominal swelling, or feeding problems.

Annulus

A ring-shaped structure or band in the body. Examples include the tough outer ring of an intervertebral disc and the fibrous rings surrounding the heart valves.

Annulus Fibrosus

The tough, outer fibrocartilaginous ring of an intervertebral disc composed of concentric lamellae of collagen fibers, which encircles and restrains the central gel-like nucleus pulposus and absorbs rotational and compressive mechanical loads.

Alternate Names:
Anulus Fibrosus

ANOCA

Chest pain or other angina symptoms when the major heart arteries do not have a severe blockage. The symptoms may result from poor function of the heart's small vessels or temporary spasm of a coronary artery.

Anodontia

Complete absence of teeth from birth, caused by failure of tooth development. It is rare and may occur with inherited conditions affecting the skin, hair, nails, and teeth.

Anogenital Tract

The connected region containing the anus, tissues around the anus, genital organs, and nearby skin and moist linings.

Anomalous Anatomy

A difference from the usual structure, number, position, origin, or pathway of an organ, blood vessel, duct, or other body part. It may cause no symptoms or may affect health, diagnosis, or surgery.

Anomalous Coronary Artery

A birth defect in which one of the heart's arteries has an unusual starting point or path. Some arteries pass between the aorta and the pulmonary artery and may be squeezed during hard exercise. This can reduce blood flow to the heart and may cause chest pain, fainting, abnormal heart rhythms, or rarely sudden cardiac death.

Alternate Names:
AAOCA; Anomalous Aortic Origin of a Coronary Artery; Congenital Coronary Artery Anomaly; ACAOS

Anomaly

Alternate name; see *Abnormality*.

Anomaly Scan

A detailed ultrasound examination usually performed around 18–22 weeks of pregnancy to assess fetal growth and organs, the placenta, and amniotic fluid, and to screen for major structural birth defects.

Alternate Names:
Mid-Pregnancy Ultrasound; 20-Week Scan; Fetal Anomaly Scan

Anomia

Difficulty finding or saying a familiar word, especially the name of an object or person, even though its meaning is known. It can occur after a stroke or with other brain or language disorders.

Anomic Aphasia

A mild, fluent form of expressive aphasia characterized by persistent difficulty naming objects, people, or words during speech and writing, while comprehension, repetition, and grammatical structure remain relatively preserved.

Alternate Names:
Nominal Aphasia; Dysnomia

Anophthalmia

A birth defect in which one or both eyes fail to develop. It may occur with other birth defects and can affect growth of the eye socket and face.

Anorchia

Complete absence of testicular tissue, usually congenital but sometimes occurring after loss of testes that formed. Bilateral absence prevents testicular production of testosterone and sperm and can affect pubertal development and fertility. It is distinct from cryptorchidism, in which testes are present but have not descended into the scrotum.

Anorectal Abscess

A collection of pus in tissues around the anus or rectum, usually caused by an infected anal gland. It may cause severe pain, swelling, fever, or difficulty sitting.

Anorectal Fistula

An abnormal tunnel between the anus or rectum and nearby skin or another organ. It often develops after an abscess or infection and may cause persistent drainage, pain, or repeated abscesses.

Anorectal Infection

Infection of the anus, rectum, or nearby tissues. It may cause pain, swelling, discharge, fever, or difficulty passing stool and can lead to an abscess.

Anorectal Malformation

A birth defect in which the anus or rectum does not form normally or does not connect correctly to the skin. The opening may be absent, misplaced, or abnormally connected to another organ.

Anorectal Manometry

A test that measures pressure and sensation in the rectum and anal canal. A thin pressure-sensitive tube assesses how well the muscles relax and tighten and may help investigate constipation or loss of bowel control.

Anorexia

Loss or reduction of appetite. It can result from illness, pain, medicines, emotional distress, or other causes and is different from anorexia nervosa, an eating disorder.

Anorexia Nervosa

A serious eating disorder involving persistent restriction of energy intake that leads to significantly low body weight, intense fear of gaining weight or persistent behaviour that prevents weight gain, and disturbance in how body weight or shape is experienced. It can cause malnutrition, slow heart rate, low blood pressure, and organ damage.

Anorgasmia

Persistent or repeated difficulty reaching orgasm or inability to reach orgasm despite adequate sexual stimulation. It may result from medicines, illness, hormonal changes, pain, stress, trauma, or relationship factors.

Anorgasmy

Another spelling of anorgasmia: persistent or repeated inability to reach orgasm despite adequate sexual stimulation. Possible causes include medicines, illness, hormonal changes, stress, trauma, or relationship factors.

Anoscopy

Examination of the anal canal using a short, lighted tube called an anoscope. It helps investigate rectal bleeding, haemorrhoids, fissures, fistulas, pain, and other problems near the anus.

Anoscopy And High-Resolution Anoscopy

Examination of the anal canal and lower rectum with a short viewing tube. High-resolution anoscopy adds magnification and special lighting to identify and assess abnormal tissue, including changes related to HPV.

Anosmia

Complete loss of the sense of smell. It may follow a viral infection, blocked or inflamed nasal passages, head injury, medicines, toxic exposure, or a neurological or inherited disorder.

Anosodiaphoria

A neurological state of apparent emotional indifference or unconcern toward severe physical disability, such as hemiplegia, despite intellectual aware-

ness and verbal acknowledgement of the deficit. It is most commonly associated with non-dominant (right) hemisphere parietal lobe lesions.

Anosognosia

Lack of awareness of, or inability to recognize, one's own illness or neurological impairment. It can occur after certain brain injuries or strokes and is not simply deliberate denial.

Anotia

A birth defect in which the outer ear is completely absent. The ear canal and middle-ear structures may also be abnormal, causing reduced hearing on the affected side.

Anovulation

Failure to release an egg from an ovary during a menstrual cycle. It can cause irregular or absent periods, abnormal bleeding, or infertility and may result from hormonal disorders, low body weight, stress, excessive exercise, or polycystic ovary syndrome.

Anoxia

Complete lack of oxygen reaching body tissues. It can quickly damage or kill cells, especially in the brain, heart, and kidneys, and may result from blocked blood flow, breathing failure, or severe poisoning.

Anrep Effect

An intrinsic physiological autoregulation mechanism of the myocardium whereby an abrupt increase in ventricular afterload causes an initial stretch followed by a sustained, positive inotropic increase in ventricular contractility over the ensuing several minutes.

Anserine Bursa

A synovial fluid-filled sac situated on the proximal medial aspect of the tibia, interposed between the tibial collateral ligament and the conjoined tendons of the sartorius, gracilis, and semitendinosus muscles; inflammation causes pes anserine bursitis.

Alternate Names:
Pes Anserinus Bursa

Antacids

Medicines that neutralise stomach acid and provide short-term relief from heartburn, indigestion, and acid reflux. Different products contain different minerals and may interact with other medicines or alter bowel movements.

Antagonist

A drug or other substance that reduces or blocks the effect of another substance. A receptor antagonist binds to a receptor without activating it and reduces the response to an agonist, often by preventing the agonist from binding or signaling.

Antagonist Muscle

A muscle that produces the opposite movement to the main working muscle and helps control or reverse that movement.

Antalgic Gait

A pain-avoiding walking pattern in which the person spends less time bearing weight on the painful limb, producing a limp. The affected side has a shortened stance phase, and the opposite step is often shortened. It is a gait feature rather than a diagnosis and may result from joint, bone, muscle, or spinal pain.

Alternate Names:
Pain-Relieving Gait; Limping Gait; Antalgic Walk

Ant Bites

Puncture injuries and venomous stings inflicted by ants, particularly fire ants, which produce immediate burning pain followed by the development of pruritic sterile pustules, wheals, or rarely systemic allergic reactions.

Antebrachium

The anatomical region of the upper limb situated between the elbow and the wrist, consisting of the radius and ulna surrounded by anterior and posterior muscular compartments.

Alternate Names:

Forearm

Antecubital Fossa

The shallow hollow at the front of the elbow. It contains the biceps tendon, a major artery, and a major nerve and is commonly used to draw blood or measure blood pressure.

Antegrade

Moving or occurring in the normal forward direction, such as blood flowing away from the heart or an electrical signal travelling through its usual pathway.

Antemortem Injury

An injury that occurred before death. It may show bleeding into living tissue, clot formation, inflammation, swelling, or early healing, which can distinguish it from damage occurring after death.

Antenatal

Relating to the period before birth or to care during pregnancy. Antenatal care monitors the pregnant person and fetus, screens for complications, and provides health advice and support.

Alternate Names:
Prenatal; Antepartum

Antepartum Fetal Surveillance

Tests used before birth to check fetal well-being, especially in higher-risk pregnancies. They may include monitoring fetal movements, the fetal heart rate, ultrasound assessment, and blood-flow measurements.

Antepartum Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the vagina during the second half of pregnancy and before birth. Causes include placenta previa, placental abruption, and problems with the cervix or vagina; severe bleeding can cause maternal or fetal compromise.

Antepartum Testing

Alternate name; see *Antepartum Fetal Surveillance*.

Anterior

Relating to the front of the body or positioned nearer the front than another structure. The term is used to describe body parts, scan findings, injuries, and disease locations.

Anterior Cerebral Artery Syndrome

A stroke syndrome resulting from occlusion or ischemia of the anterior cerebral artery, classically causing contralateral motor weakness and sensory loss predominantly affecting the lower extremity more than the upper extremity and face. Additional findings may include abulia, urinary incontinence, and frontal release signs due to medial frontal lobe involvement.

Alternate Names:
ACA Syndrome; ACA Infarction

Anterior Chamber

The fluid-filled space between the cornea and iris at the front of the eye. It contains aqueous fluid, which nourishes the cornea and lens and helps maintain eye pressure; impaired drainage can contribute to glaucoma.

Anterior Chamber Angle

The area where the cornea and iris meet at the front of the eye. It contains the main drainage tissue for aqueous fluid; blockage here can raise eye pressure and cause glaucoma.

Anterior Commissure

A transverse bundle of myelinated nerve fibers crossing the midline anterior to the columns of the fornix and above the lamina terminalis, interconnecting the olfactory bulbs, amygdalae, and middle and inferior temporal gyri across the cerebral hemispheres.

Anterior Cord Syndrome

Damage to the front part of the spinal cord, often from injury or reduced blood flow. It can cause weakness or paralysis and loss of pain and temperature sensation below the damage, while the ability to feel vibration and limb position is often preserved.

Anterior Cruciate Ligament

A strong band of tissue inside the knee that connects the thigh bone to the shin bone. It helps prevent the shin bone from sliding too far forward and controls knee rotation.

Anterior Cruciate Ligament Injury

Damage or tearing of the main stabilizing ligament inside the knee, often after sudden turning, stopping, landing, or overextension. It may cause a popping sensation, rapid swelling, pain, and a feeling that the knee gives way.

Anterior Cruciate Ligament Tear

A partial or complete tear of the ligament inside the knee that limits forward sliding and rotation of the shin bone. It commonly causes a pop, rapid swelling, pain, and knee instability after a sudden twist or landing.

Anterior Drawer Sign

Excessive forward movement of the shin relative to the thigh when the knee is bent. This finding suggests looseness or injury of the anterior cruciate ligament.

Anterior Drawer Test

A physical examination maneuver used to check the anterior cruciate ligament in the knee or the anterior talofibular ligament in the ankle. The examiner gently pulls the shin or foot forward; unusual movement may suggest ligament injury.

Anterior Interosseous Nerve

A pure motor branch of the median nerve arising in the proximal forearm that courses deeply along the anterior surface of the interosseous membrane to innervate the flexor pollicis longus, the lateral half of flexor digitorum profundus, and the pronator quadratus; damage produces the classic inability to make the "OK" sign.

Alternate Names:
AIN

Anterior Interosseous Nerve Syndrome

A pure motor neuropathy of the forearm resulting from compression or neuritis of the anterior interosseous nerve (a motor branch of the median nerve). Causes weakness of the flexor pollicis longus, pronator quadratus, and the radial half of the flexor digitorum profundus, classically producing an inability to form the ÖKšign (pinching index finger and thumb pulp-to-pulp instead of tip-to-tip).

Alternate Names:
Kiloh-Nevin Syndrome; AIN Neuropathy

Anterior Knee Pain

Pain at the front of or behind the kneecap, often worse with stairs, squatting, running, or prolonged sitting. Common causes include irritation around the kneecap, tendon problems, arthritis, and injury.

Anterior Mediastinum

The front part of the lower mediastinum, located behind the sternum and in front of the heart sac. It contains fat, connective tissue, lymph nodes, and part of the thymus.

Anterior Midline

The imaginary vertical line running down the center of the front of the body, separating the right and left sides.

Anterior Myocardial Infarction

A heart attack affecting the front wall of the main pumping chamber, usually because the left anterior descending coronary artery is blocked. It can seriously weaken the heart and cause heart failure or shock.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Heart Attack; Anterior MI

Anterior Pituitary

The front part of the pituitary gland. It releases hormones that control the adrenal and thyroid glands, growth, milk production, egg or sperm production, and reproductive function.

Anterior Placenta

An anatomical variation in pregnancy where the placenta implants and develops along the front wall of the uterus, closest to the maternal abdominal wall. It is generally a normal placental position but may cushion and reduce early perception of fetal movements.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Uterine Placental Implantation

Anterior/Posterior Drawer Test

A physical examination of knee stability. Pulling the shin bone forward tests the anterior cruciate ligament; pushing it backward tests the posterior cruciate ligament.

Anterior Segment Surgery

Eye surgery involving structures in the front portion of the eye, including the cornea, anterior chamber, iris, and lens. Procedures may address cataracts, corneal disease, glaucoma, or other disorders affecting these structures; the specific operation depends on the tissue and condition involved.

Anterior Talofibular Ligament

A short, flat ligament on the lateral aspect of the ankle that spans from the anterior margin of the lateral malleolus of the fibula to the neck of the talus. It is the primary stabilizer against anterior talar displacement and excessive inversion, and represents the most frequently torn ligament in lateral ankle sprains.

Alternate Names:
ATFL

Anterior Tibial Artery

An artery that carries blood down the front of the leg and continues onto the top of the foot as the dorsalis pedis artery. Its pulse can usually be felt near the front of the ankle.

Anterior Uveitis

Inflammation in the front part of the eye, usually involving the iris and sometimes nearby tissue. It can cause eye pain, redness, light sensitivity, blurred vision, and floating spots.

Alternate Names:
Iritis; Iridocyclitis

Anterior Vaginal Prolapse

Bulging of the anterior vaginal wall into the vaginal vault, commonly resulting from herniation of the urinary bladder (cystocele) due to attenuation or tearing of the pubocervical fascia and pelvic floor musculature. Symptoms may include a palpable vaginal bulge, pelvic heaviness, urinary frequency, urgency, incomplete emptying, or stress incontinence.

Alternate Names:
Cystocele; Bladder Prolapse; Prolapsed Bladder; Anterior Wall Prolapse

Anterior Vaginal Wall Repair

Surgery to strengthen the front wall of the vagina when the bladder bulges into it. The procedure restores support using the person's own tissues; the approach and risks depend on the prolapse and overall health.

Anterograde Amnesia

Difficulty forming new memories after the onset of brain injury or illness, while some memories from before the event may remain. Causes include brain injury, stroke, encephalitis, or alcohol-related thiamine deficiency.

Alternate Names:
Anterograde Memory Loss

Anterolateral Thoracotomy

A surgical opening into the chest through an incision between the ribs on the front and side of the chest. It gives access to the lungs, heart, and other structures in the chest. A left-sided approach is commonly used for rapid access during emergency trauma surgery and is usually made through the fourth or fifth intercostal space; it may be extended across the chest as a clamshell thoracotomy.

Anterolisthesis

Forward slipping of one spinal bone relative to the bone below it. It may result from wear, a stress fracture, injury, or a problem present from birth and may cause back pain or nerve symptoms.

Anteroposterior

Directed from the front of the body toward the back. In an anteroposterior X-ray view, the beam enters through the front and leaves through the back.

Anteverted Uterus

A position in which the uterus tilts forward relative to the vagina, toward the bladder. It is a common, normal variation. Anteversion describes the angle of the uterus as a whole, whereas anteflexion describes a forward bend between the body of the uterus and the cervix.

Alternate Names:
Anteriorly Tilted Uterus

Anthocyanin

A natural plant pigment that gives many fruits, vegetables, and flowers red, purple, or blue colours. It has antioxidant effects in laboratory studies and is found in foods such as berries, grapes, and red cabbage.

Anthophobia

An abnormal, persistent fear of flowers, flower petals, or floral arrangements, causing distress or avoidance upon exposure.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Flowers

Anthracosis

A benign, non-fibrotic form of pneumoconiosis characterized by the asymptomatic accumulation of inhaled carbon and soot pigment in the lung parenchyma, alveolar macrophages, and draining hilar lymph nodes, commonly seen in urban dwellers and cigarette smokers.

Alternate Names:
Black Lung Pigmentation; Carbon Pigmentation

Anthrax

A serious infection caused by the bacterium *Bacillus anthracis*. People can become infected through contact with infected animals or animal products, breathing in spores, or eating contaminated food; skin, lung, or intestinal disease may result.

Anthrax Blood Test

A laboratory test that looks for the anthrax bacterium or the body's immune response to it in blood or another sample. It helps confirm suspected anthrax, which can affect the skin, lungs, or digestive tract.

Anthropometry

The measurement of body size and proportions, such as height, weight, waist size, limb length, and skinfold thickness. These measurements help assess growth, nutrition, and body composition.

Anthropophobia

An intense fear of people or social interaction that can cause marked anxiety, avoidance, or difficulty functioning. It is a descriptive term and is not a distinct formal diagnosis in current diagnostic systems.

Alternate Names:
Fear of People

Antiandrogen

A medicine or substance that lowers the production or blocks the effects of androgen hormones such as testosterone. It is used for selected prostate conditions, androgen-related disorders, and some gender-affirming treatments.

Antianginal

A medicine used to prevent or relieve angina, the chest discomfort caused by reduced blood flow to heart muscle. Different medicines lower the heart's workload, widen blood vessels, or improve coronary blood flow.

Anti-Anxiety Agents

Medicines used to reduce excessive anxiety or panic. Different medicines work in different ways and may cause sleepiness, dependence, or other side effects; the choice depends on the person and the condition.

Alternate Names:
Anxiolytics

Antiarrhythmic

A medicine used to prevent or treat certain abnormal heart rhythms. Some medicines aim to restore or maintain a normal rhythm, while others control the heart rate without restoring normal rhythm. The choice depends on the rhythm, heart condition, and risks, because these medicines can also cause abnormal rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Antiarrhythmics; Antiarrhythmic Medicines

Antibacterial

Able to kill bacteria or stop them from growing. The term may describe a medicine, disinfectant, surface treatment, or part of the body's immune defence.

Antibiogram

A report showing which antibiotics are likely to work against bacteria grown from patient samples in a laboratory. It helps clinicians choose treatment and monitor local patterns of antibiotic resistance.

Antibiotic

A medicine that kills bacteria or inhibits their growth. Antibiotics act on bacterial structures or processes, such as cell-wall synthesis or protein production, and are used against susceptible bacterial infections. They do not treat viral infections. Their use can cause adverse effects and select for antimicrobial resistance.

Alternate Names:
Antibiotics

Antibiotic Misuse in Viral URIs

The inappropriate prescription or self-administration of antibacterial agents for acute viral upper respiratory tract infections (such as the common cold or influenza), which confers no therapeutic benefit and drives antimicrobial resistance and adverse drug events.

Alternate Names:
Antibiotic Stewardship in URI; Inappropriate Antibiotic Use in Colds; Antibiotic Overuse in Flu

Antibiotic-Resistant Bacterial Infection

An infection caused by bacteria that are not adequately stopped by one or more antibiotics normally active against them. Resistance may be intrinsic or acquired and can limit effective treatment options.

Antibody

A Y-shaped protective glycoprotein produced by plasma cells (differentiated B lymphocytes) that specifically binds to a complementary antigen to neutralize toxins and pathogens or mark them for destruction. See also: *Immunoglobulin*.

Alternate Names:
Immunoglobulin

Antibodies

Plural form; see *Antibody*.

Antibody-Dependent Cell-Mediated Cytotoxicity

An immune process in which antibodies bind to antigens on the surface of an infected or abnormal cell, marking it for destruction by cytotoxic effector cells (such as natural killer cells).

Alternate Names:
ADCC

Antibody-Drug Conjugate

A treatment in which an antibody carrying a linked medicine binds to a target on a cell and delivers the medicine near or inside that cell. It is used for selected cancers and can still damage healthy tissues or cause medicine-specific toxicities.

Antibody Engineering

Designing or changing antibodies so they bind more accurately, last longer, cause fewer unwanted immune reactions, or work better as medicines. Researchers may alter their target, size, immune effects, or attachment to another medicine.

Antibody Therapy

Treatment using laboratory-made or purified antibodies to block, activate, or target a particular molecule or cell. It is used for selected cancers,

immune disorders, infections, and other conditions.

Antibody Titer Blood Test

A blood test that estimates the amount of a specific antibody by repeatedly diluting the sample until the antibody can no longer be detected. Results may help show previous exposure, immunity, or a recent infection, depending on the antibody tested.

Anti-CCP

Abbreviation for cyclic citrullinated peptide antibody; see *Anti-CCP Antibody*.

Anti-CCP Antibody

An autoantibody directed against cyclic citrullinated peptides (CCP) measured in serum to assist in diagnosing rheumatoid arthritis. It demonstrates high specificity (> 95%) for rheumatoid arthritis and serves as a predictor of erosive joint disease.

Alternate Names:
Anti-Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide; ACPA

Anticholinergic

Blocking the action of acetylcholine, a chemical messenger used by nerves. These medicines can reduce secretions and muscle spasms but may cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, difficulty urinating, fast heartbeat, or confusion.

Anticholinergic Burden

The combined anticholinergic effect of one or more medicines. A high burden can cause dry mouth, constipation, blurred vision, difficulty urinating, confusion, or delirium, especially in older adults.

Anticholinergic Toxicity

Excess blockade of muscarinic acetylcholine receptors, producing flushed, dry skin, fast heartbeat, dilated pupils, delirium, urinary retention, and reduced bowel sounds.

Anticholinergic Toxidrome

A pattern of poisoning caused by excessive blockage of acetylcholine signals. It may cause dry skin and mouth, large pupils, fast heartbeat, inability to urinate, reduced bowel activity, overheating, agitation, or delirium.

Anti-Citrullinated Peptide Antibody

Alternate index label; see *Anti-Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide Antibody*.

Anticoagulant

A medicine that reduces blood clot formation by interfering with one or more steps in coagulation. It is used to prevent or treat thromboembolic disease. Unlike antiplatelet medicines, anticoagulants primarily affect the coagulation system rather than platelet activation; bleeding is an important adverse effect.

Anticoagulants and Thrombolytics in Pregnancy

Medicines that prevent clot formation or dissolve selected clots during pregnancy or after delivery. Their effects on clotting, bleeding, and fetal exposure vary by medicine and pregnancy stage.

Anticoagulation

Treatment that reduces the formation or growth of blood clots by slowing the clotting process. It is used for conditions such as clots in veins, irregular heart rhythm, and selected heart or blood-vessel disorders.

Anticodon

A group of three RNA building blocks on a transfer-RNA molecule. It pairs with a matching sequence on messenger RNA so the cell adds the correct amino acid while making a protein.

Anticonvulsants

Medicines, also called antiseizure medicines, used to prevent or control seizures. Some are also used for nerve pain, migraine, or mood disorders; their effects, interactions, and side effects differ between medicines.

Alternate Names:
Antiseizure Medicines; Antiseizure Drugs; Anticonvulsant Drugs

Anti-Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide Antibody

An autoantibody measured in blood that recognizes citrullinated proteins. A positive result can support a diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis, especially when symptoms and examination findings fit, but it does not establish the diagnosis by itself.

Alternate Names:
Anti-CCP Antibody; ACPA; Anti-Citrullinated Peptide Antibody; Anti-Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide; Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide Antibody

Anti-D

An injection containing antibodies given to an RhD-negative pregnant person after certain pregnancy events, or around birth, to prevent the person's immune system making antibodies against RhD-positive fetal blood. This helps protect a current or future pregnancy from fetal red-cell destruction.

Antideformity Position

A planned position for a limb or joint that helps prevent or limit shortening, stiffness, or deformity after injury, surgery, burns, nerve damage, or prolonged immobility.

Antidepressant Discontinuation Syndrome

A constellation of transient physiological symptoms that occurs following the abrupt cessation, dose reduction, or missed doses of an antidepressant medication, particularly selective serotonin reuptake inhibitors (SSRIs) or serotonin-norepinephrine reuptake inhibitors (SNRIs). Symptoms include flu-like discomfort, insomnia, nausea, hyperarousal, and sensory disturbances (such as electric shock-like sensations).

Alternate Names:
Antidepressant Withdrawal; SSRI Discontinuation Syndrome

Antidepressants

Medicines used mainly to treat depression. Different types change the activity of chemical messengers in the brain and may also treat anxiety, nerve pain, obsessive thoughts, or other conditions.

Antidiabetic

Relating to a medicine or treatment used to control diabetes or lower blood glucose; see *Antidiabetic Drugs*.

Antidiabetic Drugs

Medicines used to manage diabetes by replacing insulin, increasing insulin release or action, reducing glucose production or absorption, or helping the kidneys remove glucose. The appropriate medicine depends on the type of diabetes, blood glucose, other health conditions, and treatment goals.

Antidiuretic Hormone

A hormone made in the brain and released by the pituitary gland that helps the kidneys conserve water. It also narrows blood vessels when blood volume or blood pressure is low.

Alternate Names:
Vasopressin

Antidiuretic Hormone Blood Test

A blood test that measures vasopressin, the hormone that helps the kidneys conserve water. It may help investigate excessive thirst, very dilute urine, inappropriate water retention, or other disorders of water balance.

Antidiuretic Hormone Physiology

Vasopressin is made in the hypothalamus and released from the posterior pituitary when the blood becomes too concentrated or blood volume falls. It makes kidney tubules retain water and can narrow blood vessels.

Antidiuretic Hormone Resistance

Failure of the kidneys to respond properly to vasopressin. It causes production of large amounts of dilute urine and intense thirst and may result from medicines, mineral imbalance, kidney disease, or inherited changes.

Anti-DNase B Blood Test

A blood test that measures the body's antibodies against a protein made by group A streptococcal

bacteria. It can support evidence of a recent strep infection when doctors investigate rheumatic fever, kidney inflammation, or another complication.

Antidote

A substance that counteracts or limits the harmful effects of a poison. Antidotes act in different ways, including binding a toxin, blocking its effects, or restoring a chemical process disrupted by it.

Anti-Double-Stranded DNA Antibody

An autoantibody measured in blood that recognizes double-stranded DNA. It can support a diagnosis of systemic lupus erythematosus; levels may track disease activity, especially kidney involvement, in some people.

Alternate Names:
Anti-dsDNA Antibody; dsDNA Antibody; Anti-Double-Stranded DNA; Double-Stranded DNA Antibody

Antiemetics

Medicines used to prevent or relieve nausea and vomiting. Different types act on chemical signals in the brain or digestive tract, and the choice depends on the cause, age, pregnancy, other medicines, and risk of side effects.

Antiepileptic Drugs

Medicines used to prevent or control seizures by reducing excessive electrical activity in the brain. The best choice depends on the seizure type, age, other conditions, medicines, and possible side effects.

Antifreeze Poisoning

Poisoning after swallowing or otherwise being exposed to antifreeze, especially products containing ethylene glycol. It may first cause intoxication and vomiting, then severe acid buildup, kidney failure, brain injury, or death.

Antifungal Prophylaxis

Use of an antifungal medicine to prevent a serious fungal infection in someone at high risk, such as a person with prolonged low white-cell counts, a stem-cell transplant, or severe immune suppression.

Antifungal Resistance

The ability of a fungus to survive a medicine that would normally stop its growth or kill it. Resistance may be present naturally or develop after genetic changes or repeated exposure to antifungal medicines.

Anti-GBM Disease

An autoimmune disease in which antibodies attack supporting layers in the kidneys and sometimes the lungs. It can rapidly cause kidney failure, coughing up blood, or bleeding into the lungs.

Antigen

A substance or part of a substance that the immune system can recognize. It may come from a germ, toxin, transplanted tissue, or abnormal cell and can trigger antibodies or other immune responses.

Antigen Detection Test

A test that looks for a protein or other marker from a specific germ in a patient sample. It is often rapid, but it may miss an infection when the amount of germ material is small.

Antigenic Drift

The gradual change in a virus's surface proteins as it multiplies. These small changes can help viruses, especially influenza viruses, partly evade existing immunity and contribute to repeated seasonal outbreaks.

Antigenic Shift

A sudden major change in a virus's surface proteins, usually when two different influenza A viruses exchange genetic material inside the same cell. It can produce a virus to which many people have little immunity.

Antigenic Variation

Changes in a germ's surface markers that help it avoid recognition by the immune system. Variation may happen gradually through mutations or suddenly when genetic material is exchanged between different strains.

Antigen Presentation

The process by which an immune or other cell displays small pieces of proteins on its surface for T cells to inspect. This helps the immune system recognize infections, abnormal cells, transplanted tissue, and sometimes the body's own tissues.

Antigen-Presenting Cell

An immune cell that breaks proteins into small pieces and displays them on its surface so T cells can recognize them. Important antigen-presenting cells include dendritic cells, macrophages, and B cells.

Alternate Names:
APC

Antigen Receptor

A protein on an immune cell that recognizes a particular substance or protein fragment. B-cell receptors can bind whole substances, while T-cell receptors recognize fragments displayed by other cells.

Anti-Glomerular Basement Membrane Blood Test

A blood test that detects antibodies attacking the kidney's filtering membranes and sometimes the lungs' supporting membranes. A positive result supports anti-GBM disease when symptoms and other test results are consistent.

Anti-Glomerular Basement Membrane Disease

An autoimmune disease in which antibodies damage the kidney's filtering membranes and sometimes the lungs. It may cause rapidly worsening kidney function, blood in the urine, coughing up blood, or lung bleeding.

Antigout

A medicine used to prevent or treat gout. Some lower uric-acid levels over time, while others reduce the inflammation and pain of an acute gout attack.

Antihistamines

Medicines that block histamine, a chemical involved in allergy symptoms. They can relieve itching, sneezing, runny nose, watery eyes, or hives. Older types may cause drowsiness; medicines that reduce stomach acid by blocking H2 receptors are a separate group.

Antihistamines For Allergies

Medicines that block histamine and relieve allergy symptoms such as itching, sneezing, runny nose, watery eyes, or hives. Some cause drowsiness and interactions or side effects vary between medicines.

Anti-HMGCR Myopathy

A rare autoimmune muscle disease in which antibodies attack a muscle enzyme. It causes ongoing weakness and muscle injury, especially around the hips, thighs, shoulders, and upper arms, and may begin after treatment with a statin medicine.

Alternate Names:
Statin-Induced Immune-Mediated Necrotizing Myopathy; Anti-HMG-CoA Reductase Myopathy

Antihypertensives In Pregnancy

Medicines used to lower high blood pressure during pregnancy. Drug effects and risks vary by medicine and stage of pregnancy; some agents can impair fetal kidney development.

Anti-IgE Therapy

Treatment using an antibody that binds free immunoglobulin E, an allergy-related immune protein. This reduces activation of allergy cells and may lessen symptoms and attacks in selected allergic asthma and other allergic conditions.

Anti-IL4 Receptor Therapy

Treatment that blocks a cell receptor used by interleukin-4 and interleukin-13, immune signals that promote allergic inflammation. It can reduce airway inflammation in selected asthma and other allergic diseases.

Anti-IL5 Therapy

Treatment that blocks interleukin-5 or its receptor, reducing the production or survival of eosinophils, a type of white blood cell. It is used for selected

eosinophilic diseases, including some severe asthma.

Anti-Inflammatory

Pertaining to any drug, substance, or therapeutic intervention that reduces, counteracts, or suppresses inflammation, vascular permeability, tissue edema, and associated pain. Major therapeutic classes include nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs and glucocorticoids.

Anti-Insulin Antibody Test

A blood test that detects antibodies against insulin. These antibodies can bind insulin and release it unpredictably, causing low blood sugar; the test helps investigate unexplained hypoglycaemia and insulin autoimmune syndrome.

Antileukotriene

A medicine that blocks leukotrienes, chemical signals that can cause airway narrowing and inflammation. It is used in selected asthma and allergy-related conditions, often as part of a broader treatment plan.

Alternate Names:
Leukotriene Modifier; Leukotriene Pathway Inhibitor

Anti-MDA5 Dermatomyositis

A form of dermatomyositis associated with antibodies against a protein called MDA5. It often causes distinctive skin changes with little muscle weakness but carries a high risk of rapidly worsening inflammation and scarring in the lungs.

Antimetabolite

A substance that resembles a chemical needed by cells and interferes with the cell's normal chemical reactions or DNA production. Some are used to treat cancer or suppress an overactive immune system.

Antimicrobial

A substance that kills or limits the growth of microscopic organisms, including bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites. Antibiotics are antimicrobials, but they act only against bacteria.

Antimicrobial Adverse Effects

Unwanted effects caused by medicines that treat infections. Depending on the medicine, they may include allergy, diarrhoea, liver or kidney injury, hearing problems, tendon injury, or harmful effects on heart rhythm.

Antimicrobial Agent

A substance that kills microorganisms or stops them from growing. Antimicrobial agents include antibacterial, antiviral, antifungal, and antiparasitic medicines.

Antimicrobial Desensitization

A carefully supervised process of giving gradually increasing doses of an infection-fighting medicine to temporarily reduce an immediate allergy response. It is considered only when the medicine is essential and suitable alternatives are unavailable.

Antimicrobial Dosing Optimization

Choosing the infection medicine, dose, timing, route, and duration so enough medicine reaches the infection without unnecessary harm. Kidney function, liver function, body size, infection severity, and resistance are considered.

Antimicrobial Hypersensitivity Reactions

Immune reactions to an infection-fighting medicine, ranging from an itchy rash to life-threatening anaphylaxis. The timing and symptoms vary with the medicine and type of immune response.

Antimicrobial Pharmacodynamics

How an infection-fighting medicine affects a microorganism, including how much medicine and how much exposure are needed to stop or kill it. This information helps select an effective dose and schedule.

Antimicrobial Pharmacokinetics

How the body absorbs, spreads, changes, and removes an infection-fighting medicine. Kidney or liver disease, age, body size, and other medicines can change how much medicine is needed and how often it is given.

Antimicrobial Resistance

The ability of a microorganism to survive or grow despite a medicine that would normally kill it or stop its growth. Resistance can affect bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites and can spread between organisms.

Alternate Names:
AMR; Drug Resistance

Antimicrobial Resistance Mechanisms

Ways microorganisms avoid being killed by infection medicines. They may destroy or change the medicine, alter its target, prevent it entering, or actively pump it out of the cell.

Antimicrobial Resistance Surveillance

Ongoing collection and analysis of resistance results from patient samples. It shows how resistance changes over time and helps hospitals and public-health services choose effective treatment and limit spread.

Antimicrobial Sensitivity Test

A laboratory test that shows which infection-fighting medicines can stop or kill a microorganism grown from a patient sample. It helps guide treatment for a confirmed infection.

Antimicrobial Stewardship

Coordinated efforts to use infection-fighting medicines only when needed and to choose the right medicine, dose, route, and duration. This improves outcomes and limits resistance and side effects.

Antimicrobial Susceptibility Testing

Laboratory testing that estimates whether a microorganism is likely to respond to particular infection-fighting medicines. Methods include measuring growth around medicine-containing discs or in liquid; results help select treatment.

Antimicrobial Therapy

Use of antibacterial, antiviral, antifungal, or antiparasitic medicines to prevent or treat an infection. The choice depends on the microorganism, infection site, severity, resistance, and the person's health.

Antimitochondrial Antibody

An antibody that reacts with structures inside mitochondria, the parts of cells that produce energy. It is strongly associated with primary biliary cholangitis, an autoimmune bile-duct disease; its significance depends on symptoms and liver tests.

Antimony

A metallic chemical element whose compounds can be poisonous. Some antimony compounds have been used to treat leishmaniasis; exposure can affect the heart, liver, kidneys, or nervous system.

Anti-Mullerian Hormone

A hormone made by developing ovarian follicles and by cells in the testes before birth. Its blood level can help estimate ovarian follicle number or assess some reproductive and developmental conditions, but it does not measure fertility by itself.

Antineoplastic

See *Antineoplastic Drugs*.

Alternate Names:
Anticancer Agent; Antitumor Agent

Antineoplastic Drugs

Medicines used to treat cancer, including chemotherapy, targeted medicines, immunotherapies, and hormone therapies, which act in different ways and have drug-specific benefits and adverse effects.

Alternate Names:
Antineoplastic Agents; Anticancer Drugs; Anticancer Medicines; Antitumor Drugs

Anti-NMDA Receptor Encephalitis

A serious immune attack on the brain involving a receptor important for communication between nerve cells. It may cause sudden behavior or psychiatric changes, memory loss, seizures, abnormal movements, reduced consciousness, and unstable heart rate or blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Anti-N-Methyl-D-Aspartate Receptor Encephalitis;

NMDA Receptor Encephalitis

Antinuclear Antibody

A diverse family of autoantibodies directed against nucleic acids, histones, ribonucleoproteins, and other nuclear and cytoplasmic components, evaluated via indirect immunofluorescence as a primary serological screen for systemic lupus erythematosus, systemic sclerosis, mixed connective tissue disease, and Sjogren syndrome.

Alternate Names:
ANA; Antinuclear Antibodies; Antinuclear Autoantibodies; FANA

Antinuclear Antibody Panel

A comprehensive laboratory panel of specific autoantibody assays (such as anti-dsDNA, anti-Smith, anti-Ro/SSA, anti-La/SSB, and anti-RNP) utilized to characterize specific autoimmune rheumatic diseases following a positive antinuclear antibody screen.

Antinuclear Antibody Test

A blood test that screens for autoantibodies directed against cellular nuclei, commonly ordered during evaluation for systemic lupus erythematosus and other autoimmune conditions; see *Antinuclear Antibody*.

Antioxidant

A substance that limits reactions involving reactive molecules, including free radicals and some reactive oxygen or nitrogen species. The body produces antioxidant enzymes and also obtains antioxidant substances from food; these systems help protect cells from oxidative damage.

Antiparietal Cell Antibody Test

A blood test that detects antibodies against cells in the stomach lining that make acid and help absorb vitamin B12. A positive result may support autoimmune gastritis or pernicious anemia but does not prove either condition alone.

Antiparkinson

Relating to medicines used to reduce symptoms of Parkinson disease. These medicines may increase or imitate dopamine activity or change other brain signals that influence movement.

Antiphospholipid Antibodies

Autoantibodies that attach to proteins linked with cell membranes. Persistent antibodies may increase the risk of blood clots and pregnancy complications, but they can also appear temporarily after an infection or with some medicines.

Antiphospholipid Antibody

An antibody directed against proteins that bind to cell-membrane fats. Persistent antibodies may be associated with blood clots or pregnancy complications, especially when clinical features of antiphospholipid syndrome are present.

Alternate Names:
APA; aPL Antibody

Antiphospholipid Antibody Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Antiphospholipid Syndrome*.

Antiphospholipid Syndrome

An autoimmune condition in which persistent antiphospholipid antibodies occur together with blood clots or certain pregnancy complications. Assessment uses the person's medical history and blood tests; antibody positivity alone does not establish the syndrome, and positive tests generally need confirmation at least 12 weeks later.

Alternate Names:
APS; Antiphospholipid Antibody Syndrome; Hughes Syndrome; aPL Syndrome

Antiphospholipid Syndrome and Pregnancy

An autoimmune clotting disorder associated with recurrent pregnancy loss, placental insufficiency, fetal growth restriction, preeclampsia, thrombosis, or other pregnancy morbidity. Diagnosis requires compatible clinical events and persistent antiphospholipid antibodies on tests at least 12 weeks apart.

Antiplatelet

A medicine that reduces platelet activation or ag-

gregation and lowers the formation of arterial blood clots; see *Antiplatelet Agents*.

Antiplatelet Agents

Medicines that reduce the ability of platelets to stick together and form clots. They are used in selected people to lower the risk of clots in arteries, including after some heart or blood-vessel events.

Alternate Names:
Antiplatelet Drugs; Antiplatelet Medicines

Antiplatelet Therapy

Treatment with medicines that make platelets less likely to stick together. It is used in selected people to reduce clots in arteries, including after some heart attacks, strokes, or stent procedures.

Antiprotozoal

A medicine or substance that kills protozoa or stops them growing. Protozoa are microscopic parasites that can cause infections such as malaria, giardiasis, or amoebiasis.

Antipsychotic Medicine

A medication used to treat psychosis, bipolar disorder, and severe agitation by altering neurotransmitter pathways (primarily dopamine and serotonin); see *Antipsychotic*.

Alternate Names:
Antipsychotics; Neuroleptics

Antipyretic

A medicine that lowers fever and may ease related discomfort. Acetaminophen and ibuprofen are common examples. Aspirin exposure during viral illness in children has been associated with Reye syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Antipyretics; Fever-Reducing Medicines

Anti-Reflux Surgery

An operation to reduce the backward flow of stomach contents into the oesophagus by strengthening or reshaping the valve between the oesophagus and stomach. It may be considered for selected people with severe reflux or a hiatus hernia.

Antiretroviral

A medicine that acts against retroviruses, including HIV. Different antiretroviral medicines block different steps by which HIV enters cells, copies its genetic material, or makes new virus particles.

Antiretroviral Therapy

Treatment of HIV infection with a combination of medicines that block several steps in HIV reproduction. It lowers the amount of virus, protects immune function, reduces illness, and greatly lowers the chance of sexual transmission when the virus remains undetectable.

Anti-Rust Product Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing, breathing, or skin exposure to a product used to remove or prevent rust. It may burn the mouth and digestive tract or damage the lungs and other organs.

Antisepsis

Use of a chemical product on living skin or tissue to reduce harmful microorganisms and lower infection risk. It does not make tissue completely sterile; some antiseptics can injure tissue if applied improperly.

Antiseptic

A substance used on skin or other living tissue to kill or slow harmful microorganisms. Antiseptics can help reduce infection risk but may damage tissue if used incorrectly.

Antiserum

Blood serum containing antibodies against a specific germ, toxin, or other substance. It can provide temporary immune protection or help neutralize a toxin.

Anti-Smooth Muscle Antibody

An antibody that reacts with proteins in smooth muscle cells. A blood test may support autoimmune hepatitis, but low levels can also occur with other autoimmune diseases or infections and are not diagnostic alone.

Antisocial Personality

A long-term pattern of disregarding other people's rights, safety, rules, and responsibilities, often including deceit, impulsive behaviour, aggression, or lack of remorse.

Alternate Names:
Antisocial Personality Disorder

Antisocial Personality Disorder

A mental-health disorder involving a persistent pattern of violating other people's rights and social rules, deceitfulness, impulsivity, aggression, irresponsibility, or lack of remorse. The pattern begins by adolescence and continues into adult life.

Alternate Names:
ASPD; Dissocial Personality Disorder; Sociopathy

Antispasmodic Drugs

Medicines that relax involuntary muscle and reduce cramping or spasms, most often in the digestive tract. Some are also used for bladder or bile-duct spasms; side effects depend on the medicine.

Alternate Names:
Antispasmodics; Spasmolytics

Anti-SRP Myopathy

A rare autoimmune muscle disease caused by antibodies against a protein involved in making new proteins. It causes rapidly progressive weakness, especially around the hips, shoulders, and neck, and may cause difficulty swallowing.

Alternate Names:
Anti-Signal Recognition Particle Myopathy; SRP-Associated Necrotizing Myopathy

Antistreptolysin O Titer

A blood test that measures antibodies against a toxin made by group A streptococcal bacteria. A raised or rising result may show a recent strep infection when investigating rheumatic fever or kidney inflammation, but does not prove an active infection.

Antisynthetase Syndrome

An autoimmune disease in which the immune system attacks proteins needed to make other proteins. It may cause muscle inflammation and weakness, arthritis, fever, colour changes in the fingers, rough cracked skin on the hands, or lung inflammation and scarring.

Antithrombin

A natural blood protein that slows clotting by blocking thrombin and other clotting proteins, especially factor Xa. Too little antithrombin, whether inherited or acquired, increases the risk of clots in veins.

Antithrombin Deficiency

A condition in which the blood has too little or too little active antithrombin, a natural anti-clotting protein. It may be inherited or acquired and increases the risk of clots, especially in the veins.

Antithrombin III Blood Test

A blood test that measures the amount or activity of antithrombin, a protein that limits clotting. A low result may indicate inherited deficiency or may occur with liver disease, kidney protein loss, severe illness, or some treatments.

Antithrombin III Deficiency

Reduced amount or activity of antithrombin, causing increased risk of blood clots in veins. It may be inherited or result from liver disease, kidney disease, severe illness, or other causes.

Antithymocyte Globulin

A preparation of antibodies that removes or suppresses T cells, immune cells involved in transplant rejection and some autoimmune reactions. It is used in selected transplants and blood-cell disorders and can cause allergic reactions, low blood counts, and infections.

Antithyroglobulin Antibody Test

A blood test that detects antibodies against thyroglobulin, a protein used to make thyroid hormones. Raised levels may support Hashimoto thyroiditis or other autoimmune thyroid disease but do not determine thyroid function by themselves.

Anti-Thyroid Peroxidase Antibody

An autoantibody directed against thyroid peroxidase, the key enzyme required for thyroid hormone synthesis. Elevated titers are the hallmark laboratory finding in Hashimoto thyroiditis and are also present in Graves disease.

Alternate Names:
Anti-TPO Antibody; Thyroid Peroxidase Antibody

Antitoxin

An antibody or antibody preparation that binds to and neutralizes a toxin. It can provide temporary protection or treatment for selected poisonings and infections that produce toxins.

Antitubercular Agents

Medicines used to treat tuberculosis, an infection caused by *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*. Treatment commonly uses combinations of these medicines; adverse effects can involve the liver, nerves, eyes, and other organs.

Antitussive

A medicine that reduces coughing. Some act on cough-control areas in the brain, while others reduce irritation in the airways. Opioid antitussives can cause sleepiness and slow breathing.

Alternate Names:
Cough Suppressant

Anti-VEGF Injections

Injections, usually given into the eye, that block vascular endothelial growth factor, a signal that promotes abnormal blood-vessel growth and leakage. They can improve or preserve vision in several retinal diseases.

Antiviral Agent

A medicine that inhibits viral replication or another step in a virus's life cycle. Antiviral agents act against particular viruses or virus groups and are used to prevent or treat selected viral infections. They do not act against bacteria; unlike antibiotics, their targets are viral processes or virus-infected cells.

Alternate Names:
Antiviral Medicine

Anton Syndrome

A rare neurological condition characterized by cortical blindness accompanied by visual anosognosia (complete denial of blindness) and visual confabulation. Patients genuinely behave and report as if they can see, despite profound vision loss, classically caused by bilateral occipital lobe infarctions.

Alternate Names:
Anton-Babinski Syndrome; Visual Anosognosia

Antral Follicle Count

The number of small developing egg-containing sacs seen in both ovaries, usually measured by vaginal ultrasound early in the menstrual cycle. It helps estimate ovarian reserve and response to fertility medicines but does not by itself predict natural fertility.

Alternate Names:
AFC; Basal Antral Follicle Count

Antral Web

A thin, circumferential mucosal diaphragm in the gastric antrum, usually located one to two centimetres proximal to the pylorus. It can be congenital or acquired and may cause gastric outlet obstruction, nausea, postprandial vomiting, and early satiety.

Alternate Names:
Gastric Antral Diaphragm; Antral Septum

Antrochoanal Polyp

A usually noncancerous growth that starts in the lining of a cheek sinus and extends into the back of the nose. It is more common in children and young adults and may cause blockage or drainage on one side.

Antrum

A cavity or chamber within an organ. The term commonly refers to the lower part of the stomach near its outlet or the air-filled sinus in the cheek.

Anuria

Almost complete absence of urine production, often defined in an adult as less than about 100 millilitres in 24 hours. It can signal severe kidney failure, blockage, shock, or another emergency.

Anus

The opening at the end of the digestive tract through which stool leaves the body. Two ring-shaped muscles help control when stool and gas are released.

Anxiety

A feeling of worry, fear, or unease that can be a normal response to danger or stress. It becomes a disorder when it is excessive, persistent, difficult to control, or interferes with daily life.

Anxiety Disorder

Alternate index label; see *Anxiety Disorders*.

Anxiety Disorders

A group of mental-health conditions involving excessive fear, worry, or anxiety that persists, is difficult to control, or causes significant distress or impairment. Major types include generalized anxiety disorder, panic disorder, social anxiety disorder, specific phobia, agoraphobia, separation anxiety disorder, and selective mutism. Physical symptoms may include a racing heart, sweating, muscle tension, poor sleep, or stomach upset.

Anxiety in Children

Developmentally inappropriate and persistent worry, fear, or dread in pediatric populations, manifesting through behavioral changes, somatic complaints (such as stomachaches or headaches), separation distress, school refusal, or sleep disturbances.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Anxiety; Childhood Anxiety Disorders

Anxiety & Panic

Anxiety disorders involve excessive fear, worry, or physiological arousal; panic attacks are sudden episodes of intense fear with symptoms such as palpitations, breathlessness, chest discomfort, trembling, or fear of dying.

Aorta

The body's largest artery, carrying oxygen-rich blood from the left side of the heart to the rest of the body. It passes through the chest and abdomen and divides into the arteries supplying the pelvis and legs.

Aortal

Relating to the aorta, the large artery that carries blood from the heart to the body.

Aortic

Relating to the aorta, the main artery carrying blood from the heart to the body.

Aortic Aneurysm

An abnormal widening of the aorta, the large artery that carries blood from the heart to the body, caused by weakness in its wall. It may occur in the chest or abdomen and often causes no symptoms. An aneurysm can rupture; aortic dissection is a related but distinct condition in which blood separates the wall's layers.

Aortic Aneurysm Rupture

A break through the wall of an aortic aneurysm that causes severe internal bleeding. It may produce sudden chest, back, or abdominal pain, collapse, and shock and is a life-threatening emergency.

Aortic Aneurysm Screening

Testing people at increased risk for an aortic aneurysm before symptoms appear. Abdominal ultrasound is commonly used; eligibility depends on age, sex, smoking history, and family history.

Aortic Angiography

Imaging of the aorta after contrast material is given, usually with X-ray, computed tomography, or magnetic resonance imaging. It can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, tearing, or abnormal blood flow.

Aortic Arch

The curved part of the aorta between its upward and downward sections. Three major arteries branch from it to supply the head, neck, and arms; disease here can affect blood flow or press on nearby structures.

Aortic Arch Syndrome

A group of signs caused by narrowing or blockage of arteries branching from the aortic arch, reducing blood flow to the arms, head, or brain. Causes include large-vessel vasculitis, such as Takayasu arteritis, and atherosclerosis; findings may include unequal pulses or blood pressure, arm fatigue, dizziness, or neurological symptoms.

Aortic Balloon Pump

A temporary heart-support device. A catheter with a balloon is placed in the main artery in the chest; the balloon inflates and deflates with each heartbeat to improve blood flow to the heart and reduce the heart's workload.

Alternate Names:
Intra-Aortic Balloon Pump; IABP

Aortic Body

A small group of sensory cells near the aortic arch that detects changes in blood oxygen, carbon dioxide, and acidity. It sends signals to the brain to help adjust breathing and circulation.

Aortic Coarctation

Alternate name; see *Coarctation of the Aorta*.

Aortic Disease

Any disorder affecting the aorta, the body's main artery, including aneurysm, dissection, narrowing, inflammation, or fatty deposits. Some cases cause no symptoms; sudden severe chest, back, or abdominal pain can occur with acute aortic disease.

Aortic Dissection

A life-threatening condition in which a tear occurs in the inner layer of the aorta (the body's largest artery). High-pressure blood surges through the tear, causing the inner and middle layers of the aortic wall to separate or split apart and creating a second channel for blood flow. This weakens the aorta, risks sudden rupture, and can block blood flow to vital organs such as the heart, brain, kidneys, or limbs. It classically presents with sudden, severe, ripping or tearing pain in the chest or upper back.

Alternate Names:
Dissecting Aortic Aneurysm (historical); Dissecting Aneurysm (historical)

Aortic Embolism

Blockage of a downstream artery by material, often cholesterol debris or a blood clot, that has broken away from the aorta. It can suddenly reduce blood flow to a limb or organ.

Aortic Graft Infection

Infection involving an artificial graft used to repair or replace part of the aorta. It can cause fever, bloodstream infection, bleeding, or a new abnormal connection with the intestine.

Aortic Injury

Damage to the aorta, often caused by severe chest trauma or a medical procedure. A tear can cause internal bleeding, reduced blood flow, shock, and a life-threatening emergency.

Aortic Insufficiency

Leakage through the aortic valve that allows blood to flow backward into the heart's main pumping chamber. It can make the heart work harder and may eventually cause heart failure.

Aortic Intramural Hematoma

Bleeding within the middle layer of the aortic wall, usually without a visible tear through the inner lining or blood flow in a false channel as occurs in aortic dissection. It may result from rupture of tiny vessels within the wall or from a small tear not visible on imaging, and it can progress to dissection or aortic rupture.

Aortic Regurgitation

Leakage through an aortic valve that does not

close completely, allowing blood to flow from the aorta back into the left ventricle during diastole. Acute regurgitation can cause sudden pulmonary edema or shock; chronic regurgitation may enlarge and weaken the left ventricle and cause breathlessness, chest discomfort, palpitations, or heart failure. Echocardiography assesses the cause and severity.

Aortic Regurgitation Murmur

A blowing sound heard during the part of the heartbeat when the heart relaxes, caused by blood leaking backward through the aortic valve. It is often loudest along the left side of the breastbone.

Aortic Rupture

A life-threatening break through the wall of the aorta, often following an aneurysm or dissection. It can cause sudden severe chest, back, or abdominal pain, internal bleeding, collapse, and shock.

Aortic Sclerosis

Calcification, fibrosis, and thickening of the aortic valve leaflets without significant hemodynamic obstruction or restriction of valve opening. It is a common echocardiographic finding in older adults and is associated with increased cardiovascular risk.

Aortic Stenosis

Narrowing of the aortic valve that obstructs blood leaving the left ventricle. Common causes include age-related calcification, a bicuspid valve, and rheumatic disease; severe disease can cause exertional breathlessness, chest pain, fainting, left-ventricular thickening, or heart failure. Echocardiography assesses severity.

Aortic Stenosis Grading

Assessment of how severely the aortic valve is narrowed using ultrasound measurements of valve area and blood-flow speed or pressure difference. Results are generally described as mild, moderate, or severe and help guide monitoring and treatment.

Aortic Valve

A valve between the heart's left pumping chamber and the aorta. It opens to let blood leave the heart and closes to stop blood flowing backward.

Aortic Valve Disease

Narrowing, leakage, or another abnormality of the valve between the heart's left pumping chamber and the aorta. It may cause breathlessness, chest pain, tiredness, fainting, or no symptoms at first.

Aortic Valve Insufficiency

Leakage of the aortic valve that allows blood to flow backward into the left pumping chamber between heartbeats. The extra workload can enlarge or weaken the heart over time.

Aortic Valve Regurgitation

Backward leakage of blood through an aortic valve that does not close completely. The heart must pump harder, and severe or long-standing leakage can cause enlargement or heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Aortic Regurgitation; Aortic Insufficiency; Aortic Incompetence

Aortic Valve Replacement

A procedure to replace a diseased aortic valve with a mechanical or tissue valve. It may be performed through open-heart surgery or, in selected people, by a catheter-based procedure.

Alternate Names:
AVR

Aortic Valve Stenosis

Alternate index label; see *Aortic Stenosis*.

Aortitis

Inflammation of the aorta, the body's largest artery. It may result from an autoimmune disease or infection and can weaken the artery or cause narrowing, aneurysm, dissection, or leakage of the aortic valve.

Aortocaval Compression Syndrome

Dizziness, nausea, weakness, or low blood pressure that can occur when the pregnant uterus compresses major abdominal blood vessels while a person lies flat, especially later in pregnancy. The main effect is

reduced blood return to the heart; symptoms often improve when the person changes position.

Alternate Names:
Supine Hypotensive Syndrome of Pregnancy

Aortoenteric Fistula

A life-threatening direct communication between the aorta and the gastrointestinal tract, most frequently involving the third or fourth portion of the duodenum. It may occur primarily from an eroding abdominal aortic aneurysm or secondarily following prosthetic aortic reconstruction, classically presenting with minor herald gastrointestinal bleeding followed by catastrophic exsanguination.

Aortography

Imaging of the aorta after contrast material is injected, often through a catheter. It can show aneurysms, tears, narrowing, blockages, or abnormal blood-vessel connections; computed tomography or magnetic resonance imaging is often used instead.

Aortoiliac Occlusive Disease

Narrowing or blockage, usually from atherosclerosis, in the lower abdominal aorta or the arteries branching toward the pelvis and legs. It may cause buttock or thigh pain during walking, weak femoral pulses, or erectile dysfunction. The classic combination of these findings is called Leriche syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Leriche Syndrome (classic presentation)

Aortopathy

Any pathological condition or disease process affecting the structure or wall of the aorta, frequently involving dilation, aneurysm formation, or cystic medial degeneration, as seen in genetic disorders such as Marfan syndrome, Loeys-Dietz syndrome, and bicuspid aortic valve disease.

Alternate Names:
Aortic Wall Disease

Aortopulmonary Window

A rare birth defect in which an opening connects the aorta and pulmonary artery. Too much blood may flow to the lungs, causing breathing problems, poor growth, or heart failure in infancy.

APACHE II Score

A hospital scoring system that combines vital signs, laboratory results, age, and serious long-term illnesses to estimate the severity of critical illness. A higher score generally indicates greater risk, but it does not predict an individual outcome with certainty.

Apathy

Reduced motivation, interest, or emotional response. It can occur with depression, dementia, Parkinson disease, brain injury, other neurological illness, or medicines and is different from ordinary tiredness or sadness.

APC Tumor Suppressor

A protein made from the APC gene that helps control cell growth and the removal of damaged cells. Harmful changes in this gene can allow excess intestinal polyps to form and increase colorectal-cancer risk.

Apert Syndrome

A rare inherited condition in which some skull bones join too early. It causes an unusually shaped head and face and often joined fingers or toes; breathing, vision, hearing, or development may also be affected.

Apex

The tip or pointed end of a body structure. Examples include the lower pointed end of the heart, formed mainly by the left ventricle, and the upper tip of a lung.

Apex Beat

The outermost and lowest point on the precordium at which the cardiac impulse can be palpated or inspected during ventricular systole, typically located in the left fifth intercostal space along the midclavicular line.

Alternate Names:
Apical Impulse

Apgar Score

A standardized rapid evaluation of a newborn infant's clinical status, typically performed at 1 and 5 minutes after birth (and at 5-minute intervals up to 20 minutes if depressed). Five physiological signs are evaluated and scored 0, 1, or 2: Appearance (skin color), Pulse (heart rate), Grimace (reflex irritability), Activity (muscle tone), and Respiration, yielding a total score from 0 to 10. A score of 7 to 10 is considered reassuring; 4 to 6 indicates moderate depression requiring intervention; and 0 to 3 signifies severe depression requiring immediate active resuscitation.

Alternate Names:
Apgar Assessment; Newborn Apgar Score

Aphagia

Complete inability to swallow. It may result from a blockage, neurological disease, severe pain, or loss of normal swallowing-muscle function and can lead to choking, dehydration, or aspiration.

Aphakia

Absence of the eye's natural lens, usually after cataract surgery, injury, or a birth difference. It causes major focusing problems and is usually corrected with an intraocular lens, contact lens, or strong glasses.

Aphallia

A very rare birth condition in which the penis is absent because it did not develop. The urethral opening may be in an unusual place, and other urinary or genital differences may occur.

Alternate Names:
Penile Agenesis

Aphantasia

Markedly reduced or absent ability to voluntarily form mental visual images. It is a cognitive phenomenon rather than, by itself, a disease and may occur with otherwise normal vision, memory, and imagination.

Aphasia

A brain-related disorder that impairs speaking, understanding, reading, or writing language. It most often follows a stroke but can also result from head injury, brain tumour, infection, or degeneration.

Apheresis

A procedure in which blood passes through a machine that removes a selected component, such as plasma, platelets, red cells, or abnormal cells, and returns the remaining blood to the person.

Apheresis Donation

A blood donation in which a machine collects one component, such as platelets or plasma, and returns the other blood components to the donor. The process may allow more of the needed component to be collected than whole-blood donation.

Aphonia

Complete loss of the ability to produce a normal voice, although whispering may remain possible. Causes include inflammation, vocal-cord paralysis, injury, growths, nerve disease, or psychological factors.

Aphrasia

Loss or impairment of the ability to speak. The term is older and less precise than aphasia, which can affect speaking, understanding, reading, or writing.

Aphthous Stomatitis

Repeated painful ulcers on the moist lining of the mouth, commonly called canker sores. They are usually shallow, heal without scarring, and are not contagious.

Aphthous Ulcer

A painful, noncontagious ulcer of the moist lining of the mouth, commonly called a canker sore. Most heal within one to two weeks, although larger ulcers may last longer.

Apical

Relating to or located at the tip of a body structure, such as the tip of a lung, heart, or tooth.

Apical Ballooning Syndrome

A temporary weakening and ballooning of the main pumping chamber of the heart, often after severe emotional or physical stress. It can resemble a heart attack but usually occurs without a blocked coronary artery.

Apical Periodontitis

Inflammation or infection around the tip of a tooth root, usually caused by infected or dead pulp. It may cause pain when biting, swelling, or no symptoms and is assessed with dental examination and imaging.

Apical Pulse

The heartbeat counted by listening over the tip of the heart, usually on the left side of the chest. It may be used when the pulse at the wrist is difficult to feel or when an accurate heart rate is needed.

Apicoectomy

Dental surgery that removes the tip of a tooth root and nearby infected tissue, usually when infection persists after root-canal treatment. The end of the root is then sealed.

Aplasia

Failure of an organ, tissue, or group of cells to develop, causing it to be absent or severely underdeveloped. It may be present from birth or result from inherited disease, injury, infection, or severe damage to the cells that produce it.

Aplasia Cutis Congenita

A birth defect in which a localized area of skin, most often on the scalp, is absent or incompletely formed. It may heal as a scar or hairless patch and can coexist with an underlying skull or vascular abnormality, especially when the lesion is large or atypical.

Aplastic

Describing a tissue that has failed to develop or produce its normal cells. The term is often used for bone-marrow failure, in which too few red cells, white cells, and platelets are made.

Aplastic Anemia

A rare, serious bone-marrow failure disorder in which the marrow cannot make enough blood cells, usually because blood-forming stem cells are damaged. It lowers red cells, white cells, and platelets—not just red cells—so it can cause tiredness, infections, and easy bruising or bleeding. Causes include immune attack, some medicines, toxic chemicals, radiation, infections, and inherited conditions; sometimes no cause is found.

Aplastic Crisis

A sudden, temporary stop in red-cell production that causes a rapid worsening of anemia. It most often follows parvovirus B19 infection in people whose red cells already have a shortened lifespan, such as those with sickle-cell disease.

Apley Compression Test

A physical examination manoeuvre used to evaluate for meniscal tears of the knee joint. With the patient prone and the knee flexed to ninety degrees, the examiner applies downward axial force to the heel while rotating the tibia internally and externally; pain or joint line clicking indicates meniscal pathology.

Alternate Names:
Apley Grinding Test; Apley's Compression Test

Apley Distraction Test

A clinical examination technique used to differentiate collateral ligament injuries from meniscal tears. With the patient prone and the knee flexed to ninety degrees, the examiner stabilizes the posterior thigh and applies upward traction to the lower leg with internal and external rotation; localized pain suggests ligamentous sprain rather than meniscal damage.

Alternate Names:
Apley's Distraction Test

Apley Grind Test

A physical examination maneuver used in orthopedics to evaluate meniscus tears of the knee. With the patient prone and the knee flexed to 90 degrees, the examiner stabilizes the thigh, applies downward axial compressive force onto the heel while externally

and internally rotating the tibia; pain or mechanical clicking indicates a torn meniscus.

Alternate Names:
Apley Compression Test; Apley Meniscal Test

Apley Scratch Test

A shoulder examination in which a person reaches behind the head and then behind the back. It gives a quick estimate of shoulder movement; limited or painful reach can have several causes and does not identify a specific injury by itself.

Alternate Names:
Apley Scratch Maneuver; Apley Shoulder Test

APLS

Abbreviation for antiphospholipid syndrome, an autoimmune disorder associated with venous or arterial thrombosis and pregnancy complications, with persistent antiphospholipid antibodies.

Apnea

Temporary cessation of breathing, with no airflow into or out of the lungs. It may result from airway obstruction or reduced brain signals driving respiration; effects depend on its cause and duration. Prolonged apnea can lower blood oxygen, raise carbon dioxide, impair consciousness, and progress to cardiac arrest or death.

Apnea-Hypopnea Index

The average number of complete or partial breathing interruptions during each hour of sleep, measured in a sleep study. It helps describe sleep-apnea severity, but symptoms, oxygen levels, and other findings also matter.

Apnea of Infancy

Repeated pauses in breathing in an infant. Causes and significance vary with age and clinical context; apnea of prematurity is a distinct diagnosis in preterm infants.

Apnea Of Prematurity

Repeated pauses in breathing in a premature infant because breathing control is not fully developed. Episodes may lower oxygen or slow the heartbeat and require monitoring and, when necessary, breathing support.

Apneic

Relating to a period when breathing has stopped temporarily. Apneic episodes may occur during sleep, illness, poisoning, seizures, or severe airway blockage and can quickly lower oxygen.

Apneustic Breathing

An abnormal pattern with an unusually long pause after breathing in. It usually indicates serious injury to the brainstem and may occur with other signs of severe neurological damage.

Apnoea

Alternate British spelling; see *Apnea*.

Apocrine

Relating to a secretion mechanism in which the apical part of a secretory cell buds off with its contents. The term also names certain glands, such as apocrine sweat glands, whose secretion in humans occurs mainly by merocrine exocytosis without loss of cell material.

Apocrine Hidrocystoma

A benign cyst of an apocrine sweat gland, commonly presenting as a translucent or bluish, dome-shaped papule near the eyelid or elsewhere on the skin. It may enlarge with heat or sweating and is usually diagnosed clinically.

Apoenzyme

The protein part of an enzyme before its required helper substance has attached. It is usually inactive or less active until the helper, called a cofactor, binds to it.

Apolipoprotein B100

A protein on cholesterol-carrying particles such as low-density and very-low-density lipoproteins. Its blood level estimates the number of particles that can contribute to fatty buildup in artery walls.

Apolipoprotein CII

A protein on fat-carrying particles in the blood that activates an enzyme needed to break down triglycerides. Too little or faulty apolipoprotein CII can cause triglycerides to rise to very high levels.

Apolipoproteins

Proteins attached to fats in the blood that help transport and process cholesterol and triglycerides. Different apolipoproteins are found on different fat-carrying particles and have different effects.

Aponeurosis

A broad, flat sheet of tough connective tissue that attaches a muscle to bone, another muscle, or other tissues and helps transmit the muscle's force.

Apophenia

Seeing meaningful patterns or connections in unrelated or random events. Mild experiences can occur normally, while marked or distressing experiences may occur with some psychiatric or neurological conditions.

Apophyses

Bony projections that grow from or arise near a bone and usually provide attachment for muscles or ligaments. Unlike the main growth plate of a long bone, an apophysis does not normally increase the bone's length.

Apoptosis

A controlled process of cell death in which a cell dismantles itself and is removed with little inflammation. It helps shape developing organs and remove old, damaged, or abnormal cells; failure of this process can contribute to cancer.

Apoptosis Extrinsic Pathway

A controlled cell-death process that begins when an outside signal attaches to a death receptor on a cell's surface. Internal enzymes then take the cell apart in an orderly way, usually without causing the swelling and inflammation of an injury.

Apoptosis Intrinsic Pathway

A controlled cell-death process that begins with severe stress inside a cell, such as DNA damage, lack of growth signals, or lack of oxygen. The cell's energy-producing structures then release signals that activate enzymes to dismantle it.

Apoptotic Body

A small membrane-bound piece of a cell that has begun controlled cell death. Immune or neighbouring cells can recognize and remove these pieces without causing much inflammation.

Appalachian Type Amyloidosis

A rare hereditary transthyretin amyloidosis variant associated with abnormal amyloid deposition, often causing neuropathy, autonomic symptoms, or heart involvement. Diagnosis requires genetic and tissue or specialized laboratory evaluation.

Apparent Mineralocorticoid Excess

A rare inherited disorder in which cortisol acts too strongly on the kidneys because it is not changed into an inactive form normally. It can cause severe high blood pressure, low potassium, and unusually low levels of renin and aldosterone.

Appendageal

Relating to structures that develop from the skin, including hair follicles, sweat glands, and oil-producing glands.

Appendectomy

Surgery to remove the appendix, usually to treat appendicitis. It may be performed laparoscopically through small incisions using a camera or through a larger open incision; the approach depends on the condition and clinical needs.

Alternate Names:
Appendicectomy; Appendix Removal

Appendiceal

Relating to the appendix, a narrow, finger-shaped pouch attached to the beginning of the large intestine.

Appendiceal Adenocarcinoma

A cancer arising from gland-forming cells in the appendix. It may be found after appendicitis or unexpectedly and can spread through the abdominal lining; outlook depends on its type, size, and spread.

Appendiceal Cancer

Cancer arising in the appendix. Types include neuroendocrine tumours, mucin-producing tumours, and adenocarcinoma; some can rupture and spread tumour cells or mucus through the abdomen.

Appendiceal Rupture

A tear or hole in an inflamed appendix that allows infected material into the abdomen. It can cause peritonitis, an abscess, sepsis, or severe abdominal pain.

Appendiceal Tumors

Tumours arising in the appendix, including neuroendocrine tumours, mucin-producing tumours, and adenocarcinoma. Some cause no symptoms, while others cause appendicitis, pain, blockage, or abdominal swelling.

Appendicitis

Inflammation of the appendix, often after its opening becomes blocked by hardened stool, mucus, or swollen tissue. It commonly causes pain that moves to the lower right abdomen, nausea, loss of appetite, and fever and can lead to rupture.

Alternate Names:
Epityphlitis; Acute Appendicitis

Appendicitis in Children

Acute inflammation of the appendix, a common surgical emergency in childhood. Symptoms may include abdominal pain that shifts from around the navel to the lower right abdomen, fever, or vomiting; atypical presentations are common, especially in young children. Perforation is more frequent at diagnosis in children than in adults.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Appendicitis

Appendicolith

A small, often calcified deposit inside the appendix. It can block the appendix and is linked to appendicitis, but it may also be found in people who do not have appendicitis.

Alternate Names:
Appendiceal Calculus

Appendicular Skeleton

The bones of the arms and legs and the shoulder and pelvic girdles that attach them to the central skeleton.

Appendix

A small, finger-shaped pouch attached to the beginning of the large intestine. It contains immune tissue and may help support healthy gut bacteria, although its exact function is not fully understood and it is not essential for digestion. Inflammation of the appendix is called appendicitis.

Appendix Cancer

A group of malignancies arising in the appendix, including adenocarcinoma, goblet cell adenocarcinoma, and neuroendocrine neoplasms. Appendiceal mucinous tumors require specific classification: low- and high-grade appendiceal mucinous neoplasms are distinct from invasive mucinous adenocarcinoma. Older labels such as “goblet cell carcinoid” are no longer preferred.

Appendix Testis

A small remnant of tissue near the upper part of the testis, left over from early development. It is usually harmless but can sometimes twist and cause pain in boys.

Appetite

The psychological desire to eat food, distinct from physiological hunger, modulated by central nervous system pathways, neuroendocrine signaling, sensory stimuli, emotional states, and metabolic demands.

Appetite Regulation

The control of hunger and fullness by the brain,

digestive tract, hormones, emotions, habits, sleep, and surroundings. Signals such as ghrelin promote hunger, while leptin and other signals help promote fullness.

Applied Behavior Analysis

A structured approach that observes behaviour and uses learning principles, practice, and reinforcement to build useful skills or reduce behaviour that interferes with daily life. Goals are individualized and respectful of the person.

Apposition

Placement of two structures next to or against each other. In wound care, good apposition means that the edges of a cut are accurately aligned so they can heal.

Apprehension Test

A provocative orthopedic examination maneuver designed to detect joint instability, most commonly applied to the shoulder (glenohumeral joint) or knee (patellofemoral joint). In the anterior shoulder apprehension test, the examiner places the arm in 90 degrees of abduction and maximal external rotation; a positive test occurs when the patient exhibits visible fear, alarm, or resistance due to a feeling of impending anterior subluxation or dislocation. In the patellar apprehension test (Fairbank's sign), lateral displacement of the patella elicits anxiety and quadriceps contraction.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Apprehension Test; Crank Test; Fairbank's Apprehension Test

Appropriate For Gestational Age

Describing a fetus or newborn whose estimated size or weight is within the expected range for the number of weeks of pregnancy, commonly between the 10th and 90th percentiles.

Apraxia

Difficulty performing a learned, purposeful movement even though strength, sensation, coordination, and understanding are sufficient. It results from a problem in the brain's planning of movement rather than simple weakness.

Apraxia of Speech

A neurogenic motor speech disorder characterized by an impaired ability to plan, sequence, and program the sensorimotor commands necessary for phonetically normal speech production in the absence of significant neuromuscular weakness or paralysis. Marked by inconsistent articulatory errors, effortful groping, and disrupted prosody.

Alternate Names:
Verbal Apraxia; Speech Apraxia

Apraxic Gait

A higher-level neurological gait disorder characterized by the loss of the ability to coordinate voluntary stepping and leg movements in the absence of primary sensory loss, weakness, or cerebellar ataxia. Patients exhibit hesitation in initiating walking, a wide-based stance, short shuffling steps, and a tendency for the feet to appear glued to the floor (m̈agnetic gaiẗ), commonly seen in normal pressure hydrocephalus, bilateral frontal lobe lesions, and advanced subcortical vascular encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Gait Apraxia; Frontal Gait Disorder; Magnetic Gait; Bruns Apraxia

Aprosodia

A neurological speech and language disorder characterized by an inability to express or comprehend the emotional tone, rhythm, pitch, and melody (prosody) of verbal communication. It is classically associated with lesions of the non-dominant (right) cerebral hemisphere in areas homologous to Broca and Wernicke expressive and receptive language regions.

Alternate Names:
Dysprosody; Affective Agnosia of Speech

APS

Abbreviation for antiphospholipid syndrome, though it can refer to other terms in different contexts.

AP X-Ray

An X-ray view in which the beam enters through the front of the body and exits through the back. It is called an anteroposterior view.

Aquagenic Keratoderma

Temporary painful whitening, thickening, and wrinkling of the palms or soles after contact with water. It may cause prickling or burning, is often associated with cystic fibrosis, and usually settles after the skin dries.

Aquagenic Pruritus

A condition characterized by severe, intense, prickling or stinging itching of the skin that develops rapidly after contact with water of any temperature, occurring without visible skin changes or hives. It may be idiopathic or secondary to polycythemia vera.

Alternate Names:
Water-Induced Itching

Aquaphobia

An excessive, irrational fear of water, leading to intense anxiety when in or near bodies of water such as swimming pools, rivers, lakes, or oceans.

Alternate Names:
Hydrophobia (Psychological); Fear of Water

Aquaporin

A channel in a cell membrane that lets water pass through. Aquaporin-2 in kidney tubules responds to vasopressin and helps the kidneys return water to the blood instead of losing it in urine.

Aquatic Therapy

Exercise or rehabilitation performed in water. Water buoyancy reduces load on joints while water resistance strengthens muscles and supports balance, movement, and conditioning.

Aqueous Flare

A hazy beam seen in the clear fluid at the front of the eye during slit-lamp examination. It means inflammation has allowed proteins to leak into the eye and may occur with uveitis, infection, injury, or surgery.

Aqueous Humor

The clear fluid in the front part of the eye. It nourishes the cornea and lens, removes waste, and helps maintain pressure and the shape of the eye.

Arachidonic Acid Pathway

A major cellular lipid metabolic cascade in which arachidonic acid, released from cell membrane phospholipids by phospholipase A2, is converted into bioactive eicosanoids (prostaglandins, prostacyclin, thromboxane A2, and leukotrienes) via cyclooxygenase and lipoxygenase enzymes.

Arachnitis

An older spelling of arachnoiditis, chronic inflammation and scarring of the arachnoid membrane around spinal or cranial nerves that can cause persistent pain, sensory symptoms, weakness, or bladder and bowel dysfunction.

Arachnodactyly

Abnormally long, thin fingers or toes. It may occur alone or as a feature of inherited connective-tissue disorders such as Marfan syndrome.

Arachnoidal Fibroblastoma

A rare benign or low-grade tumor arising from fibroblastic cells of the arachnoid coverings. Symptoms depend on location and may result from compression of the brain, spinal cord, or nerves.

Arachnoid Cyst

A usually noncancerous, fluid-filled sac between layers of the membrane covering the brain or spinal cord. Many cause no symptoms, but a large cyst may cause headache, seizures, weakness, or pressure on nearby tissue.

Arachnoid Cysts

Plural form; see *Arachnoid Cyst*.

Arachnoid Granulations

Macroscopic tufted outgrowths of the arachnoid membrane that project through the dura mater into the dural venous sinuses, predominantly the superior sagittal sinus, serving as the primary structural pathway for the passive reabsorption of cerebrospinal fluid into venous blood.

Alternate Names:
Pacchionian Bodies; Arachnoid Villi

Arachnoiditis

Inflammation of the arachnoid, one of the membranes covering the brain and spinal cord, most often in the spine. Inflammation may cause thickening, scarring, and bands that make nerve roots stick together or interfere with the normal flow of cerebrospinal fluid. Possible causes include infection, bleeding around the spinal cord, spinal injury, chronic nerve compression, surgery or another spinal procedure, and chemical irritation. Symptoms may include severe or burning back and limb pain, numbness, tingling, weakness, abnormal reflexes, or problems with bladder or bowel function. The course may remain stable or worsen over time.

Arachnoid Mater

The middle of three thin membranes covering the brain and spinal cord. The space beneath it contains the fluid that cushions the nervous system and carries important blood vessels.

Arachnophobia

An intense, irrational, and debilitating fear of spiders and other arachnids, representing one of the most prevalent specific animal phobias.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Spiders

Arbovirus

A virus spread by a biting insect or tick, such as a mosquito, tick, or sandfly. Arboviruses can cause fever, rash, joint pain, bleeding, or inflammation of the brain, depending on the virus.

Arbovirus A Chikungunya Type

An older classification term for chikungunya virus, a mosquito-borne alphavirus that causes fever and often severe inflammatory joint pain, rash, headache, and muscle pain.

ARBs

Medicines that block the main receptor for angiotensin II, relaxing blood vessels and reducing salt and water retention. They lower blood pressure and can protect the heart and kidneys in selected conditions, but are usually not combined with ACE inhibitors.

Arcanobacterium haemolyticum Infection

An infection caused by *Arcanobacterium haemolyticum*, which commonly causes pharyngitis in adolescents and young adults. It may cause fever, sore throat, tonsillar exudate, tender neck nodes, and occasionally a scarlatiniform or morbilliform rash; it can resemble group A streptococcal infection.

Arciform

Having a curved or arch-like shape. The term may describe the appearance of a skin lesion, rash, blood vessel, or other body structure.

Arcuate Uterus

A mild variation in the shape of the inside top of the uterus, present from birth, that creates a shallow curved indentation. It is usually considered a normal variant and generally has little or no effect on fertility or pregnancy.

Arcus Senilis

A greyish-white, circular lipid deposition ring appearing in the peripheral corneal stroma, commonly seen in elderly individuals as a benign finding, or in younger patients (arcus juvenilis) associated with familial hyperlipidemia.

Alternate Names:
Corneal Arcus; Arcus Lipoides; Gerontoxon

ARDS

Abbreviation for Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome; see that entry.

Area Under The Concentration-Time Curve

A measure of the total amount of a medicine in the blood over a period of time. It helps compare how medicines are absorbed and removed and can guide dosing for selected treatments.

Aregenerative Anemia

Anemia with an inappropriately low reticulocyte response, indicating inadequate red-cell production by the bone marrow. Causes include iron, vitamin B12, or folate deficiency, kidney disease, inflammation, endocrine disease, marrow failure, and some medicines.

Arenaviruses

A family of viruses carried mainly by rodents. Some cause serious human diseases, including viral haemorrhagic fevers, after exposure to infected rodent urine, droppings, saliva, or contaminated dust.

Areola

The darker circular area surrounding the nipple. It contains small glands that help lubricate and protect the skin, especially during breastfeeding.

ARG Deficiency

Abbreviation for arginase deficiency, an inherited urea-cycle disorder in which arginine accumulates and can cause progressive spasticity, developmental problems, seizures, and elevated ammonia.

Argentine Hemorrhagic Fever

A serious viral illness caused by Junín virus, an arenavirus carried by rodents in parts of Argentina. It can cause fever, weakness, bleeding, and nervous-system problems.

Arginine Vasopressin Resistance

Reduced kidney responsiveness to arginine vasopressin, causing excessive production of dilute urine and increased thirst. It is the modern term for nephrogenic diabetes insipidus and may result from inherited disorders, kidney disease, medicines, or electrolyte abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
Nephrogenic Diabetes Insipidus; AVP Resistance

Argininosuccinate Lyase Deficiency

An inherited urea-cycle disorder caused by deficient argininosuccinate lyase. Argininosuccinic acid and ammonia can accumulate, causing poor feeding, vomiting, liver problems, developmental impairment, or life-threatening hyperammonemia.

Argininosuccinic Aciduria

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot safely remove waste nitrogen produced when protein is broken down. Ammonia and argininosuccinic acid build up and may cause vomiting, sleepiness, seizures, liver problems, or developmental impairment.

Argon Plasma Coagulation

A procedure that uses electrically charged argon gas to deliver heat to the surface of tissue. It can stop bleeding or destroy selected abnormal tissue, often during an endoscopic examination.

Alternate Names:
APC; Argon Plasma Hemostasis

Argyll Robertson Pupil

A small, irregular pupil that becomes smaller when focusing on a nearby object but reacts poorly or not at all to light. It is classically associated with late syphilis affecting the nervous system, but other causes are possible.

Argyria

An irreversible condition characterized by blue, bluish-grey, or metallic discoloration of the skin and mucous membranes, caused by chronic exposure to or ingestion of silver compounds or colloidal silver, leading to silver particles depositing in dermal tissue.

Alternate Names:
Silver Poisoning (Cutaneous)

Arias-Stella Reaction

A benign change in cells lining the uterus or

cervix caused by pregnancy hormones or hormone medicines. Under a microscope it can resemble cancer, so the clinical setting and other findings are important.

Arithmophobia

An irrational and persistent fear of numbers or calculating mathematics, producing anxiety symptoms when confronted with mathematical tasks or specific numerals.

Alternate Names:
Numerophobia; Fear of Numbers

Arm

The part of the upper limb between the shoulder and elbow. In everyday language, "arm" may also mean the entire upper limb, including the forearm and hand.

Arm CT Scan

A scan that uses X-rays and computer processing to create cross-sectional images of the arm. It can show fractures, bleeding, inflammation, masses, and other structural problems.

Arm Fracture

A break in one or more bones of the upper limb, usually the upper arm bone or one of the forearm bones. It may cause pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or inability to move the arm normally.

Arm MRI Scan

A scan that uses a magnetic field and radio waves to create detailed images of the arm. It can show muscles, tendons, ligaments, nerves, bone marrow, blood vessels, and masses without X-ray radiation.

Arm Pain

Pain in the shoulder, upper arm, elbow, forearm, or nearby tissues. Causes include muscle or tendon injury, nerve compression, arthritis, and blood-vessel disease; sudden severe pain with chest discomfort or breathlessness can accompany a heart attack.

Alternate Names:
Brachialgia; Upper-Limb Pain

Armpit Lump

A lump or swelling in the armpit, commonly caused by an enlarged lymph node, skin infection, cyst, or noncancerous growth. Less commonly, it may be caused by a cancer or systemic disease.

Armpit Yeast Infection

A yeast infection of the skin folds in the armpit, usually caused by *Candida*. It can cause a red, itchy, burning rash, sometimes with small spots around its edges.

Alternate Names:
Axillary Candidiasis

Arnold-Chiari Malformation

A birth defect in which part of the lower brain extends through the opening at the base of the skull into the spinal canal. It may block the normal flow of brain fluid and cause headache, neck pain, balance problems, swallowing difficulty, or weakness.

Aromatase

An enzyme that changes androgen hormones into oestrogen. It is found in tissues including the ovaries, fat, and breast and helps regulate hormone levels.

Aromatase Excess Syndrome

A rare inherited condition in which too much aromatase causes excess oestrogen production. It may cause breast development in males and early puberty, rapid growth followed by short adult height, or other hormone-related changes.

Arousal Index

The average number of brief awakenings or shifts to lighter sleep during each hour of a sleep study. A high result suggests repeatedly interrupted sleep, but its importance depends on symptoms and other sleep-study findings.

Arrector Pili

A small involuntary muscle attached to a hair follicle. When it contracts, it raises the hair and produces goosebumps.

Arrector Pili Muscle

The small involuntary muscle attached to each hair follicle. Nerve signals can make it contract, raising the hair and producing temporary goosebumps.

Alternate Names:
Piloerector Muscle; Arrectores Pilorum

Arrested Caries

A dental caries lesion that has stopped progressing, often because mineral loss has ceased and the surface has become hard, smooth, and shiny. It may remain inactive or become active again if the local environment favors renewed decay.

Arrhythmia

An abnormal heart rate or rhythm. The heartbeat may be too fast, too slow, irregular, or start from the wrong place; some arrhythmias are harmless, while others reduce blood flow or cause cardiac arrest.

Arrhythmias

Plural form; see *Arrhythmia*.

Arrhythmogenic Cardiomyopathy

An umbrella term for myocardial disorders associated with ventricular arrhythmias that are not explained by ischemic, hypertensive, or valvular heart disease. Depending on the classification used, it may include right- or left-dominant forms and other disorders. Its scope varies among expert groups, and it is broader than arrhythmogenic right ventricular cardiomyopathy.

Alternate Names:
ACM

Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Cardiomyopathy

An inherited disease in which heart muscle, especially in the right pumping chamber, is replaced by scar tissue and sometimes fat. This can cause dangerous irregular rhythms, fainting, or sudden cardiac arrest, particularly during exercise.

Alternate Names:
ARVC; Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Dysplasia

Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Dysplasia

Older name; see *Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Cardiomyopathy*.

Arsenic

A naturally occurring element that is poisonous in many forms. Exposure can cause vomiting, diarrhoea, nerve problems, heart problems, skin changes, and increased cancer risk; some compounds have limited medical uses.

Arsenic Poisoning

Illness caused by sudden or long-term exposure to arsenic. Acute poisoning can cause severe vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea. Long-term exposure, especially to inorganic arsenic in drinking water or food, can cause skin darkening and thickening, nerve and other organ problems, and increased risk of skin, lung, or bladder cancer.

Alternate Names:
Arsenic Toxicity; Arsenicosis

Arsenic Toxicity

Harm caused by arsenic exposure. It may affect the digestive system, heart, nerves, blood, skin, and nails; severe exposure can be fatal.

Artemisinin

A compound originally obtained from the sweet-wormwood plant and used with other antimalarial medicines. Malaria parasites can become resistant to artemisinin when it is used alone.

Arteria Femoralis

The femoral artery, the main artery supplying the thigh and lower limb. It continues from the external iliac artery below the groin and can be felt or accessed near the groin.

Arterial Blood Gas

A blood test, usually from an artery at the wrist, that measures acidity, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and bicarbonate. It helps assess breathing, oxygen delivery, and acid–base disorders.

Arterial Blood Gas Analysis

A diagnostic blood test performed on arterial blood to assess oxygenation, ventilation (carbon dioxide elimination), and systemic acid-base balance; see *Arterial Blood Gas*.

Arterial Blood Gas Analyzer

A machine that measures acidity, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and related values in arterial blood. The results help assess how well a person is breathing and whether the blood is too acidic or alkaline.

Arterial Catheter

A thin tube placed in an artery, often at the wrist, to measure blood pressure continuously and take repeated blood samples. Possible complications include bleeding, infection, clotting, or reduced blood flow.

Arterial Catheterization

Placement of a thin tube in an artery, usually at the wrist, for continuous blood-pressure monitoring or repeated arterial blood tests. It is used when close monitoring is needed and can cause bleeding, infection, clotting, or reduced circulation.

Arterial Dissection

A pathological process in which a disruption or tear in the tunica intima allows circulating blood under pressure to enter and cleave the media, creating a false lumen that tracks longitudinally along the arterial wall and may lead to vessel occlusion or rupture.

Arterial Duplex

An ultrasound test that shows the structure of arteries and measures blood flow through them. It can detect narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or whether a vascular graft remains open.

Arterial Embolism

Sudden blockage of an artery by material carried in the bloodstream, usually a blood clot. It can abruptly cut off blood flow to a limb, brain, kidney, intestine, or other organ and cause ischemia or infarction.

Arterial Embolization

A procedure that deliberately blocks a selected artery, usually to stop bleeding, reduce blood supply to a tumour, or treat an abnormal blood-vessel connection.

Arterial Injury

Damage to an artery that may cause severe bleeding, a clot, narrowing, reduced blood flow, tissue loss, or life-threatening complications. It can result from trauma, surgery, or a medical procedure.

Arterial Insufficiency

Reduced blood flow through an artery to a tissue or limb, usually because the artery is narrowed or blocked. It may cause pain with walking, pain at rest, cool skin, slow-healing wounds, or weak pulses.

Arterial Line

A thin tube placed in an artery, usually at the wrist, for continuous blood-pressure monitoring and repeated arterial blood sampling. It is used in critical illness or major surgery and can cause bleeding, infection, clotting, or reduced circulation.

Arterial Resistance

The opposition blood encounters as it flows through arteries, especially the small arteries that can narrow or widen. It helps control blood pressure and how much blood reaches each tissue.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Resistance

Arterial Spin Labeling

An MRI method that uses magnetically labeled blood as a natural tracer to measure blood flow, especially in the brain, without injecting a tracer.

Arterial Stenosis

Narrowing of an artery that reduces blood flow to the tissues beyond it. Common causes include fatty plaque, inflammation, injury, or an inherited abnormality of the artery wall.

Arterial Stick

Puncture of an artery with a needle, usually to obtain an arterial blood sample. It may cause temporary pain or bruising and, rarely, bleeding, arterial injury, or reduced blood flow.

Arterial Stiffness

Reduced ability of arteries to expand and recoil with each heartbeat. It is associated with ageing, high blood pressure, diabetes, kidney disease, and fatty artery disease and is linked with higher cardiovascular risk.

Arterial Switch Operation

Open-heart surgery usually performed in newborns whose two main arteries leave the wrong pumping chambers. The arteries and coronary arteries are reconnected so blood flows normally; possible long-term complications include coronary artery problems, valve leakage, and narrowing of the arteries.

Alternate Names:
Jatene Procedure; ASO

Arterial Tension

A measurement taken from arterial blood. Depending on the context, it may mean blood pressure inside an artery or the amount of oxygen or carbon dioxide dissolved in the blood.

Arterial Thoracic Outlet Syndrome

The rarest form of thoracic outlet syndrome, occurring when the subclavian artery is compressed as it exits the chest, frequently by an anomalous cervical rib or abnormal first rib, causing upper-extremity ischemia, coldness, pallor, diminished pulses, or arterial aneurysm formation.

Alternate Names:
Arterial TOS; Subclavian Artery Compression Syndrome

Arterial Thromboembolism

Blockage of an artery by a blood clot that formed elsewhere and travelled through the bloodstream. It can suddenly reduce blood flow to the brain, heart, limb, kidney, intestine, or another organ.

Arterial Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot inside an artery, often where a fatty plaque has damaged the vessel lining. The clot can block blood flow to the heart, brain, limb, intestine, or another organ.

Arterial Ulcer

A slow-healing wound caused by poor blood flow through an artery, usually on a toe, heel, or other pressure point. It may be deep and sharply outlined, with a pale or dead-looking base and cool, shiny, hairless surrounding skin.

Arteries

Blood vessels that carry blood away from the heart. Most carry oxygen-rich blood, but the pulmonary and umbilical arteries carry oxygen-poor blood; strong elastic and muscular walls help withstand and regulate pressure.

Alternate Names:
Arterial Vessels

Arteriogram

An image of an artery, usually made after contrast material is injected. It can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, abnormal connections, or other changes in blood flow.

Arteriography

An imaging study in which contrast material is injected into an artery and X-ray images show the arterial lumen and blood flow.

Arteriole

A small terminal branch of an arterial vessel that regulates blood flow into capillary beds. Its smooth-muscle wall alters vascular resistance and systemic blood pressure through vasoconstriction and vasodilation.

Alternate Names:
Resistance Vessels; Small Arteries

Arterioles

Plural form; see *Arteriole*.

Arteriolosclerosis

A form of vascular disease affecting small arteries and arterioles, characterized by mural thickening, luminal narrowing, and loss of elasticity, classically manifesting as hyaline arteriolosclerosis (associated with aging and diabetes) or hyperplastic arteriolosclerosis (associated with severe hypertension).

Arterioportal Shunting

Abnormal flow of blood from a hepatic artery into the portal venous system through a direct or small-vessel connection. It may be congenital or develop with cirrhosis, a liver tumor, trauma, or a liver procedure; large shunts can alter portal blood flow and contribute to portal hypertension.

Alternate Names:
Arterioportal Shunt; Hepatic Arterioportal Shunt

Arteriosclerosis

Thickening, hardening, and loss of elasticity in artery walls. It encompasses multiple vascular processes, including age-related medial stiffening and intimal plaque buildup. See also: *Atherosclerosis*.

Arteriosclerotic Retinopathy

Damage or changes in the retina caused by thickened, narrowed, or hardened small blood vessels, most often after long-standing high blood pressure. Severe disease can reduce vision.

Arteriovenous Fistula

An abnormal connection between an artery and a vein that bypasses the normal capillary network. It may be present from birth, follow injury or a procedure, or be created to provide access for haemodialysis.

Arteriovenous Fistula Creation

Surgery to connect an artery to a nearby vein to create blood access for hemodialysis. Over time, the vein may become wider and stronger so it can be used for dialysis needles. It often has advantages over a graft or catheter, but its success, risks, and long-term usefulness vary from person to person.

Alternate Names:
AV Fistula Creation; Arteriovenous Fistula Surgery; Hemodialysis Fistula Placement; AVF Construction

Arteriovenous Graft

An artificial tube connecting an artery and vein to provide access for haemodialysis, usually when a person's veins cannot form a suitable fistula. It can clot or become infected.

Arteriovenous Malformation

An abnormal connection between an artery and a vein that bypasses the tiny blood vessels (capillaries) that normally link them. Arteriovenous malformations can occur in the brain, spinal cord, lungs, or other organs. Their effects depend on where they are and may include bleeding or damage to nearby tissue. Very high-flow malformations can sometimes strain the heart.

Alternate Names:
AVM

Arteriovenous Malformation Resection

Microsurgery to remove a brain arteriovenous malformation (AVM), an abnormal cluster of blood vessels (nidus) that connects arteries to veins without a normal capillary network. Through an opening in the skull, the surgeon disconnects the AVM from its blood supply and removes it. Imaging after surgery checks whether any AVM remains.

Alternate Names:
AVM Resection; Surgical Excision of Brain AVM; Cerebral AVM Removal

Arteriovenous Nicking

A change seen on retinal examination in which a thickened arteriole appears to narrow or deflect the vein where they cross. It is associated with chronic vascular changes, often related to high blood pressure, but is not specific enough to diagnose or grade hypertension by itself.

Alternate Names:
AV Nicking; Gunn's Sign; Arteriovenous Crossing Changes

Arteritis

Inflammation of an artery wall. The inflammation can narrow, weaken, or block the artery, reducing

blood flow and causing pain or organ damage in the affected area.

Artery

A blood vessel that carries blood away from the heart. Most arteries carry oxygen-rich blood, except the pulmonary arteries, which carry oxygen-poor blood to the lungs. Their elastic, muscular walls withstand and regulate pressure.

Artery Occlusion

A blockage inside an artery, often caused by a clot, fatty plaque, or material that travelled from elsewhere. It can cut off blood flow and cause pain, paleness, coldness, numbness, weakness, or absent pulse.

Arthralgia

Pain in one or more joints. It describes a symptom rather than a specific disease and may occur with or without joint inflammation. Causes include injury, overuse, infection, osteoarthritis, and autoimmune disorders; the painful joint may also be swollen, warm, or stiff.

Arthritis

A group of conditions that affect joints and the tissues around them; it is not one single disease. Depending on the type, arthritis may involve inflammation, gradual breakdown of joint tissues, infection, or crystal deposits. It can cause joint pain, swelling, warmth, stiffness, and reduced movement. Some types can also affect the skin, eyes, heart, lungs, or other organs. Examples include osteoarthritis, rheumatoid arthritis, gout, and ankylosing spondylitis.

Alternate Names:
Joint Inflammation; Articular Inflammation

Arthritis in Hands

Inflammation or wear-related damage in the joints of the fingers, thumb, or hand. Osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis are common causes. It may cause pain, swelling, stiffness, or bony enlargements of the finger joints.

Alternate Names:
Hand Arthritis

Arthritis in Knee

Inflammation or wear-related damage in the knee joint. Osteoarthritis is a common cause, but other forms of arthritis can also affect the knee. Symptoms may include pain, stiffness, swelling, and reduced movement.

Alternate Names:
Knee Arthritis

Arthritis of the Wrist

Inflammation or degenerative disease affecting one or more wrist joints. Pain, swelling, stiffness, reduced grip, and limited motion may result from osteoarthritis, rheumatoid arthritis, crystal disease, injury, infection, or other inflammatory disorders.

Arthritis, Osteoarthritis

Alternate name for degenerative joint disease; see *Osteoarthritis*.

Arthritis Urethritica

An older name for reactive arthritis, inflammatory arthritis occurring after certain gastrointestinal or genitourinary infections and sometimes accompanied by urethritis, conjunctivitis, or skin findings.

Arthrocentesis

A procedure in which a needle removes fluid from a joint. The fluid can be tested for infection, blood, or crystals and may be removed to reduce pain and pressure.

Arthrodesis

Surgery that permanently joins the bones of a damaged joint so they heal as one solid unit. It can relieve severe pain and improve stability, but the fused joint no longer moves.

Arthrogram

An image of a joint taken after contrast material is placed inside or around it. It can show tears or problems in cartilage, ligaments, the joint capsule, or other joint structures.

Arthrography

Imaging of a joint after contrast material is injected into it. It can help examine the shoulder, hip, wrist, knee, or another joint when ordinary imaging does not show enough detail.

Arthrogryposis

A group of conditions present from birth in which two or more joints are permanently stiff or limited in movement. It usually results from reduced movement before birth and may involve muscles, nerves, or connective tissue.

Arthrogryposis Multiplex Congenita

A group of birth conditions causing stiffness and limited movement in several joints. The affected joints may be in the arms, legs, jaw, or spine, and muscle weakness or abnormal nerves and connective tissue may also be present.

Arthrolysis

A procedure that releases scar tissue or other restrictions around a stiff joint to improve movement. It may be performed through small cuts with a camera or through open surgery.

Arthropathy

Any disease or abnormal condition affecting a joint. It may result from inflammation, wear, injury, infection, bleeding, nerve damage, or crystals such as those that cause gout.

Alternate Names:
Joint Disease

Arthroplasty

Surgery to repair, reshape, or replace a damaged joint to reduce pain and improve movement or alignment. It may replace part or all of the joint and is used for severe arthritis, fractures, or other joint damage.

Arthropod Vector

An insect, tick, or related animal that carries and transmits an infectious organism between hosts. Examples include mosquitoes spreading malaria or ticks spreading Lyme disease.

Alternate Names:
Disease Vector

Arthroscope

A thin instrument with a light and camera used to look inside a joint through a small cut. It can help diagnose damage and guide keyhole surgery to repair or remove abnormal tissue.

Arthroscopy

Keyhole surgery in which a camera and small instruments are inserted through small cuts to examine or treat a joint. It may be used to repair cartilage or ligaments, remove loose tissue, or treat an inflamed joint lining.

Arthrosis

Degenerative damage or wear of a joint, involving loss of cartilage and changes in the underlying bone. Osteoarthritis is the most common example and can cause pain, stiffness, and reduced movement.

Arthus Reaction

A local immune reaction that causes redness, swelling, pain, and sometimes tissue damage several hours after exposure to a substance. It occurs when antibodies and the substance form deposits that activate inflammation in the affected tissue.

Articular Cartilage

Smooth, tough tissue covering the ends of bones inside a joint. It allows bones to move with little friction and helps spread forces across the joint.

Articular Cartilage Injuries

Damage to the smooth cartilage covering the ends of bones in a joint, sometimes extending into the underlying bone. It may cause pain, swelling, catching, or reduced movement and can follow injury, repeated stress, or joint disease.

Articular Ligament

A strong band of connective tissue joining bones around a joint. It stabilizes the joint and limits

excessive bending, sliding, or twisting.

Alternate Names:
Joint Ligament

Articulation

A joint or connection between bones. In speech, articulation also means forming clear speech sounds using the tongue, lips, teeth, and other speech organs.

Articulation Disorder

A speech sound disorder in which an individual has difficulty producing individual speech sounds correctly with the tongue, lips, teeth, and palate, resulting in substitutions, omissions, distortions, or additions of speech sounds.

Alternate Names:
Speech Articulation Disorder; Phonetic Disorder

Artifacts

Distortions or false features in a medical image that do not represent real body structures. They may result from movement, metal, air, the imaging beam, or limits of the scanner and image-processing method.

Artificial Abortion

Older term; see *Induced Abortion*.

Artificial Heart

A mechanical device that supports or replaces the heart's pumping action. It may support one or both lower chambers temporarily or long term and requires management of power, infection, bleeding, and blood clots.

Artificial Insemination

A fertility procedure in which prepared sperm is placed into the cervix or uterus to increase the chance of pregnancy. The sperm may come from a partner or a donor.

Artificial Insemination By Donor

Fertility treatment in which sperm from a screened donor is placed into the uterus or cervix to attempt pregnancy. It may be used when partner sperm is unavailable or unlikely to result in pregnancy.

Artificial Insemination By Husband

Fertility treatment in which prepared sperm from a woman's husband or male partner is placed into the uterus or cervix to increase the chance of fertilization and pregnancy.

Artificial Intelligence

Computer systems that learn from data to recognize patterns, make predictions, or support healthcare decisions. Clinical AI performance depends on validation, monitoring for bias, and qualified professional oversight.

Alternate Names:
AI

Artificial Kidney

A dialysis device that removes metabolic waste and excess fluid from blood and helps correct electrolyte disturbances when renal function is inadequate.

Artificial Pacemaker

An implanted device that sends electrical signals to the heart when its natural rhythm is too slow or irregular. It helps maintain an adequate heart rate and may have one or more leads.

Artificial Rupture Of Membranes

Deliberate breaking of the amniotic sac during labour or an examination. It may be used to start or strengthen labour, assess the amniotic fluid, or attach internal monitors; it carries risks such as infection and umbilical-cord prolapse.

Artificial Saliva

A product that moistens the mouth and temporarily relieves discomfort from dry mouth. It may improve speaking, swallowing, and comfort but does not replace fluids, dental care, or treatment of the cause.

Alternate Names:
Saliva Substitute

Artificial Skin

A biological or manufactured covering placed over a wound to protect it and support growth of new skin. It may reduce fluid loss and contamination, but some wounds later need a permanent skin graft.

Alternate Names:
Skin Substitute

Artificial Sweeteners

Sweet-tasting substances used in place of sugar that provide few or no calories. They include chemically synthesized compounds and substances derived from plants; their sweetness and metabolism vary by type.

Artificial Urinary Sphincter

An implanted device that controls urine leakage by gently closing and releasing the urethra. It is used for selected severe stress incontinence and requires surgery and follow-up to operate and maintain the device.

Artificial Ventilation

Support or replacement of breathing with a machine that moves air and oxygen into and out of the lungs when a person cannot breathe well enough alone. It may use a mask or a tube and requires close monitoring.

Artificial Ventricle

A mechanical device that helps or replaces the pumping action of one or both lower heart chambers in severe heart failure. The exact device and treatment goal vary.

Alternate Names:
Ventricular Assist Device

Aryepiglottic Fold

A triangular mucosal fold enclosing ligamentous and muscular fibers, extending bilaterally from the lateral margins of the epiglottis to the arytenoid cartilages, forming the lateral anatomical boundaries of the laryngeal inlet.

Arytenoid Cartilage

One of a pair of small cartilages at the back of the voice box. They anchor the vocal cords and help the laryngeal muscles open, close, and adjust the cords for breathing and speech.

ASA Physical Status Classification System

A scale used before anesthesia to summarize a patient's overall health and major medical conditions, from healthy to severely ill. It helps the care team communicate risk but does not by itself predict complications or outcome.

Asbestosis

Permanent scarring of the lungs caused by long-term inhalation of asbestos fibres. It can gradually cause breathlessness, dry cough, and reduced lung function and increases the risk of lung cancer and mesothelioma.

Asbestos-Related Disorders

Diseases that may develop years after breathing asbestos fibres, including pleural plaques, lung scarring, lung cancer, and mesothelioma. Risk increases with greater exposure and smoking; symptoms may include breathlessness, cough, or chest pain.

Ascariasis

An infection caused by the intestinal roundworm Ascaris lumbricoides, acquired by swallowing eggs from contaminated soil, food, or water. Many infections cause no symptoms, but heavy worm burdens can cause abdominal pain, malnutrition, or bowel obstruction, as well as cough and wheezing while the larvae migrate through the lungs.

Alternate Names:
Ascaris Infection; Roundworm Infection; Ascaris Lumbricoides Infection

Ascaris Lumbricoides

A large parasitic roundworm that infects the human intestines. It is transmitted when microscopic eggs in contaminated soil, food, or water are swallowed.

Alternate Names:
Giant Human Roundworm

Ascending Aorta

The first section of the aorta, rising from the heart's left pumping chamber. It gives rise to the coronary arteries and continues into the aortic arch; an aneurysm or dissection here can be life-threatening.

Ascending Aortic Aneurysm

An enlarged, weakened area in the part of the aorta that rises from the heart. It may be associated with a bicuspid aortic valve, inherited connective-tissue disease, high blood pressure, or artery-wall disease and may rupture or dissect.

Ascending Cholangitis

A bacterial infection of the bile ducts caused by obstruction, usually from a common bile-duct stone or tumor, with infection of stagnant bile. It may cause fever, chills, right-upper-quadrant pain, and jaundice; severe cases can progress to confusion and septic shock. Blood tests may show leukocytosis and raised bilirubin, while imaging can show bile-duct dilation.

Alternate Names:
Acute Cholangitis; Acute Suppurative Cholangitis; Biliary Sepsis

Ascending Colon

The first part of the large intestine, running upward on the right side of the abdomen from the appendix region to the bend beneath the liver. It absorbs water and helps form stool.

Ascites

Extra fluid collecting in the space around the abdominal organs. It often happens with severe liver disease, but cancer, heart failure, pancreatitis, and other conditions can also cause it. It may make the belly swell, feel uncomfortable, or make breathing harder.

Ascitic Fluid

Fluid collected from the abdomen in a person with ascites. Laboratory testing can help identify liver disease, infection, cancer, pancreatitis, or other causes of the fluid buildup.

Alternate Names:
Ascitic Effusion

Ascorbic Acid

Vitamin C, a water-soluble vitamin needed to make collagen, heal wounds, absorb iron, protect cells, and support normal immune and connective-tissue function.

Ascus

A Pap-test result meaning that some cells from the cervix look slightly unusual, but it is unclear whether the change is important. Its risk classification depends on age, HPV testing, and previous results; it is not a cancer diagnosis.

ASD

Abbreviation for atrial septal defect; see *Atrial Septal Defect*.

Asepsis

The condition or practice of preventing contamination by disease-causing microorganisms, especially during medical or surgical procedures. It includes sterile technique, environmental controls, hand hygiene, and appropriate handling of instruments and materials.

Aseptic

Free from disease-causing contamination, or performed using methods that prevent microorganisms from entering a wound, specimen, medicine, or body site. Aseptic does not necessarily mean completely sterile.

Aseptic Fever

A fever caused by something other than an infection, such as inflammation, injury, cancer, or a medicine. The term means infection is not thought to be the cause; it does not mean the person is otherwise well. Unlike fever of unknown origin, the cause of an aseptic fever is known.

Aseptic Loosening

Loss of firm attachment of an artificial joint or other implant without an active infection. Repeated stress

or a reaction to tiny wear particles can cause pain, instability, and eventual implant failure.

Aseptic Meningitis

Inflammation of the membranes around the brain and spinal cord without the usual evidence of bacterial meningitis. Viruses are common causes, but medicines, autoimmune disease, and other infections can also be responsible.

Aseptic Necrosis

Death of bone tissue caused by impaired blood supply without infection; see *Osteonecrosis*.

Alternate Names:
Avascular Necrosis; Osteonecrosis; Ischemic Bone Necrosis

Aseptic Technique

Practices used to prevent harmful microorganisms contaminating a wound, body site, medicine, or specimen. They include hand hygiene, clean or sterile equipment, surface cleaning, and limiting contact with exposed sterile items.

Asherman Syndrome

Symptoms caused by scar bands inside the uterus, such as light or absent periods, pelvic pain, infertility, or pregnancy loss. The adhesions often follow a procedure inside the uterus, especially after pregnancy; see also *Intrauterine Adhesions*.

Ashman Phenomenon

A temporary wide-looking heartbeat that occurs when a short beat follows a long pause, often during atrial fibrillation. It can resemble a dangerous rhythm on an ECG, so clinicians interpret it with the full tracing and the person's symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Ashman's Phenomenon; Aberrant Intraventricular Conduction

ASL

American Sign Language, a complete visual language used by many Deaf and hard-of-hearing people. It is a primary language for many members of Deaf communities and is distinct from signed versions of spoken English.

ASOT

An abbreviation for the antistreptolysin O test, a blood test measuring antibodies against a toxin made by group A streptococcal bacteria. It can help show a recent strep infection when investigating later complications.

Asp

The standard three-letter abbreviation for aspartic acid, an amino acid used to build proteins and involved in energy production and other cell reactions.

Aspartame

A low-calorie sweetener made from two amino-acid components. It is not suitable for people with phenylketonuria because it releases phenylalanine when digested.

Aspartate Aminotransferase

An enzyme found mainly in the liver, heart, muscles, and red blood cells. When these tissues are injured, the enzyme can enter the blood and its level may rise.

Aspartate Aminotransferase Blood Test

A blood test measuring the level of the enzyme aspartate aminotransferase. A high result can indicate injury to the liver, heart, muscles, or red blood cells; other tests help identify the source.

Aspartate Aminotransferase Test

A blood test that measures aspartate aminotransferase, an enzyme found in the liver, heart, and skeletal muscle; elevated levels suggest cellular injury, particularly hepatic or cardiac tissue damage. See *Aspartate Aminotransferase* and *Liver Function Tests*.

Aspartic Acid

An amino acid that the body can make and uses to build proteins and carry out cell reactions. It is one of the components of aspartame but is not the

same substance as the sweetener.

Asperger Syndrome

An older name for a form of autism. It was used for autistic people who did not have major delays in learning to speak or in intellectual development. It is no longer a separate diagnosis; clinicians now use autism spectrum disorder. A person given this diagnosis in the past may still use the name.

Alternate Names:
Asperger Disorder; Asperger's Syndrome; Asperger's Disorder

Aspergillosis

A group of infections and allergic conditions caused by Aspergillus molds. It may affect the airways, sinuses, or lungs and can include allergic disease, a fungal growth in an existing lung cavity, or invasive infection.

Alternate Names:
Aspergillus Infection; Aspergillus Disease

Aspergillosis Precipitin

A qualitative or semi-quantitative serological test detecting circulating precipitating IgG antibodies against *Aspergillus* antigens, useful in diagnosing chronic pulmonary aspergillosis and allergic bronchopulmonary aspergillosis.

Alternate Names:
Aspergillus Antibodies; Aspergillus IgG Precipitins

Aspergillus

A genus of saprophytic molds whose airborne conidia are ubiquitous in the environment, capable of causing allergic bronchopulmonary aspergillosis, aspergilloma formation in pre-existing cavitary lung lesions, or severe invasive tissue infections in immunocompromised hosts.

Aspergillus Infection

Alternate index label; see *Aspergillosis*.

Asphalt Cement Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing, inhaling, or having significant skin contact with hot or solvent-containing asphalt cement. Burns, breathing problems, dizziness, or chemical injury can occur.

Asphyxia

A life-threatening lack of oxygen caused by inability to breathe or by blocked blood oxygen delivery, such as from choking, drowning, strangulation, or severe airway blockage. It can quickly cause unconsciousness, brain injury, or death.

Asphyxial Death Pathology

Autopsy findings associated with impaired oxygenation or ventilation, which may include congestion, petechiae, pulmonary edema, and visceral hypoxia. These findings are usually nonspecific and vary with the circumstances, history, and toxicology.

Asphyxia Neonatorum

Failure of a newborn to start or maintain effective breathing at or soon after birth. It can reduce oxygen to the brain and other organs, causing hypoxic injury.

Asphyxiating Thoracic Dysplasia

A rare inherited disorder in which short ribs create a narrow, stiff chest that restricts breathing, especially in infancy. Kidney, liver, and limb abnormalities may also occur.

Alternate Names:
Jeune Syndrome

Aspirate

Fluid, cellular material, tissue fragments, or particulate matter evacuated from a cavity, cyst, organ, or lesion via negative-pressure suction; or foreign liquid and solid material accidentally inhaled into the tracheobronchial tree.

Alternate Names:
Aspirated Material; Biopsy Aspirate

Aspiration

Breathing food, liquid, saliva, vomit, blood, or another substance into the voice box or lungs instead of swallowing it into the oesophagus. It can cause choking, airway blockage, inflammation, or pneu-

monia.

Aspiration Pneumonia

A lung infection that develops after inhaling saliva, food, liquid, or stomach contents. It is more likely with swallowing difficulty, reduced consciousness, stroke, or tube feeding and may cause cough, fever, breathlessness, or chest pain.

Aspiration Pneumonitis

Chemical inflammation of the lungs after inhaling stomach contents, especially acidic fluid. It can cause coughing, wheezing, low oxygen, breathing difficulty, and fluid or collapse in parts of the lungs.

Aspiration Pneumonitis and Pneumonia

Aspiration pneumonitis is an acute chemical lung injury after inhaling gastric contents; aspiration pneumonia is infection after inhaling contaminated material. Both may cause fever, cough, hypoxia, or lung infiltrates.

Aspiration Risk

The likelihood that food, liquid, saliva, or stomach contents will enter the airway or lungs. Risk increases with swallowing difficulty, stroke, reduced alertness, nerve or muscle disease, reflux, and some dental or feeding problems.

Aspirin

A medicine that can relieve pain, lower fever, reduce inflammation, and make platelets less likely to form blood clots. Low-dose aspirin is used for selected people with cardiovascular disease, but it can cause serious bleeding and is not suitable for everyone.

Alternate Names:
Acetylsalicylic Acid; ASA

Aspirin-Exacerbated Respiratory Disease

A condition involving asthma, chronic nasal or sinus inflammation with polyps, and respiratory reactions to aspirin or some similar pain medicines. Exposure may trigger wheezing, nasal blockage, cough, or shortness of breath.

Aspirin Overdose

Acute or chronic poisoning resulting from excessive salicylate ingestion. Characteristic features include tinnitus, nausea, vomiting, hyperventilation causing early respiratory alkalosis, followed by severe uncoupled oxidative phosphorylation, high anion gap metabolic acidosis, hyperthermia, confusion, seizures, and noncardiogenic pulmonary edema.

Alternate Names:
Salicylate Toxicity; Aspirin Poisoning; Salicylism

Aspirin Poisoning

Alternate name; see *Aspirin Overdose*.

Asplenia

Absence or severe loss of spleen function. It may result from spleen removal, the spleen not developing, or a disease such as sickle cell disease. It raises the risk of severe infections, especially from encapsulated bacteria such as pneumococcus, meningococcus, and *Haemophilus influenzae* type b.

Alternate Names:
Absence of Spleen; Functional Asplenia

Assay

A laboratory method used to detect or measure a substance, biological activity, genetic feature, or response in a sample.

Assist-Control Ventilation

A ventilator setting that gives a full preset breath whenever the patient starts one and also gives breaths at a minimum rate if the patient does not breathe enough. Each breath is set by volume or pressure.

Assisted Breech Delivery

A vaginal birth in which the baby's buttocks or feet come first and a trained clinician helps deliver the body and head. It is considered only in carefully selected circumstances because breech birth can be dangerous for the baby or pregnant person.

Assisted Circulation

Mechanical or procedural support that maintains

blood flow when the heart cannot pump enough on its own. It may use a pump, oxygenator, or other device for a short time or longer-term support.

Alternate Names:
Mechanical Circulatory Support

Assisted Delivery With Forceps

A vaginal birth in which a trained clinician places specially shaped instruments around the baby's head to help complete delivery. It may be considered when labour is prolonged or the baby or pregnant person needs delivery sooner.

Assisted Living

A residential setting where people receive help with daily activities such as bathing, dressing, meals, medicines, or transport while retaining some independence. It generally does not provide the continuous skilled nursing care of a hospital or nursing home.

Assisted Reproductive Technology

Clinical, surgical, and laboratory procedures that involve the in vitro manipulation of human oocytes, spermatozoa, or embryos to achieve pregnancy, including in vitro fertilization (IVF), intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI), gamete intrafallopian transfer (GIFT), and frozen embryo transfer.

Alternate Names:
ART; Assisted Reproduction; Assisted Conception

Assistive Device

Equipment that helps a person move, communicate, perform daily activities, or remain independent. Examples include a cane, wheelchair, hearing aid, communication tool, brace, walker, or adapted household equipment.

Assistive Device Training

Instruction in choosing, fitting, using, and maintaining equipment such as walkers, canes, crutches, braces, or wheelchairs, including safe walking, transfers, and stair use.

Association

A relationship in which two findings, events, or conditions occur together more often than expected. An association alone does not prove that one causes the other.

Association Cortex

Areas of the brain's outer layer that combine information from different senses. They support memory, language, planning, judgment, learning, and other complex behavior rather than controlling one simple movement or sensation.

Association Study

A research study examining whether a genetic variant, exposure, or other factor occurs more often with a particular disease or finding. Such a relationship does not prove that the factor causes the disease.

Asteatotic Eczema

A dry-skin eczema pattern, also called eczema craquelé, in which fine fissures create a cracked or porcelain-like appearance, usually on the shins, arms, or trunk of older adults. Cold, dry weather, frequent washing, and diuretics can worsen it; emollients and treatment of inflammation help.

Alternate Names:
Eczema Craquelé; Winter Eczema; Winter Itch; Xerotic Eczema

Astereognosis

Inability to recognize a familiar object by touch alone even though basic touch sensation works. It usually results from damage to a brain area that combines sensory information, often after a stroke or other brain injury.

Asterixis

Brief, repeated lapses in holding a posture that cause a flapping movement, often when the arms are stretched out and the wrists are bent back. It can occur with liver or kidney failure, breathing disorders, or some medicines.

Asteroid Hyalosis

A usually harmless eye condition in which tiny calcium-and-fat particles float in the gel inside the eye and appear as bright spots. It often affects one eye and causes few symptoms, but dense particles can obscure the retina.

Asthenia

Abnormal lack of physical strength or energy. It is a symptom rather than a disease and may occur with infection, chronic illness, malnutrition, depression, or medicine effects.

Asthenic

Describing a person or condition marked by weakness, or sometimes a slender body build. In a clinical note, the surrounding context shows which meaning is intended; asthenia specifically means reduced strength or energy.

Asthenopia

Eye strain or visual fatigue that may cause aching, burning, blurred vision, headache, or difficulty focusing. Refractive errors, dry eyes, poor lighting, and prolonged screen use can contribute.

Asthenozoospermia

Abnormally reduced movement of sperm, which can make fertilization more difficult. It is assessed by semen analysis and may result from infection, a varicocele, toxins, illness, or an unknown cause.

Alternate Names:
Asthenospermia

Asthma

A chronic inflammatory disease of the airways in the lungs characterized by bronchial hyperresponsiveness and variable, typically reversible expiratory airflow limitation (reversing spontaneously or with bronchodilator therapy). When triggered, airway inflammation, bronchospasm, and mucus hypersecretion lead to episodes of wheezing, shortness of breath, chest tightness, and cough, which often vary over time and in intensity. Common triggers include respiratory viral infections, allergens, cold air, exercise, smoke, and occupational irritants.

Asthma Attack

A sudden worsening of asthma in which inflamed, narrowed airways make breathing difficult. It may cause wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or breathlessness; severe attacks can cause hypoxemia, exhaustion, or respiratory failure.

Asthma Controller Medications

Medicines used regularly to reduce airway inflammation and prevent asthma symptoms and attacks. Inhaled corticosteroids are the main controller medicines; other classes may be combined with them according to the asthma regimen.

Alternate Names:
Asthma Controllers; Long-Term Control Medications

Asthma-COPD Overlap

A pattern in which a person has features of both asthma and chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, such as variable symptoms together with persistent airflow limitation. The term describes overlapping features rather than a single, separately defined disease.

Asthma Exacerbation

A sudden or gradual worsening of asthma symptoms and airflow through the lungs. It may cause increasing wheeze, cough, chest tightness, or breathlessness and can become life-threatening.

Asthma in Older Adults

Asthma occurring later in life can be difficult to distinguish from chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, heart disease, deconditioning, or medication effects. It is characterized by variable respiratory symptoms and reversible or variable airflow limitation.

Asthma in Pregnancy

Asthma may improve, worsen, or remain unchanged during pregnancy. Poorly controlled asthma can cause maternal hypoxia and affect fetal oxygenation; symptoms and lung function may vary during pregnancy.

Asthma Medications

Medicines for asthma include regular treatments that reduce airway inflammation and reliever treatments that quickly ease narrowed airways. The regimen depends on symptoms, lung function, attack risk, age, pregnancy, inhaler technique, and response.

Asthma Quick-Relief Medications

Medicines used to ease asthma symptoms quickly by opening narrowed airways or reducing airway inflammation. They may include a short-acting bronchodilator or an inhaled corticosteroid–formoterol combination.

Alternate Names:
Asthma Relievers; Rescue Medications

Astigmatism

A common refractive error in which the cornea or lens has an irregular or unequal curvature, so light does not focus evenly on the retina. It can cause blurred or distorted vision at any distance and may occur alone or with nearsightedness or farsightedness.

Astraphobia

An irrational and overwhelming fear of thunder and lightning, causing marked panic, anxiety, and hiding behavior during storms.

Alternate Names:
Brontophobia; Keraunophobia; Fear of Thunder and Lightning

Astringent

A substance that makes surface tissues contract and may reduce minor secretions or bleeding. Astringents are used in some skin, mouth, and wound products; they can irritate tissue, especially when applied repeatedly or to sensitive surfaces. Some work by causing surface proteins to precipitate.

Astroblastoma, MN1-Altered

A rare, circumscribed glial tumour of the central nervous system, classified as this entity when characteristic histology is accompanied by an *MN1* gene alteration. It most often arises in the cerebral hemispheres. Local recurrence can occur, and its molecular definition helps distinguish it from other central nervous system tumours with similar microscopic features.

Alternate Names:
Astroblastoma

Astrocyte

A star-shaped support cell in the brain and spinal cord. It helps nourish nerve cells, maintain the blood–brain barrier, regulate the chemical environment, and respond to injury.

Astrocytoma

A tumour arising from astrocytes, the star-shaped support cells of the brain or spinal cord. Astrocytomas vary from slow-growing to aggressive, and symptoms depend on their location and size.

Astrovirus Infection

An acute viral infection of the gastrointestinal tract caused by human astroviruses, a leading cause of non-bacterial gastroenteritis primarily in infants, young children, the elderly, and immunocompromised patients. It presents with watery diarrhea, mild abdominal pain, low-grade fever, and vomiting, typically resolving spontaneously within 2 to 4 days with oral rehydration therapy.

Alternate Names:
Astrovirus Gastroenteritis; Human Astrovirus Infection

Asymmetrical

Unequal in shape, size, distribution, or appearance between corresponding sides. Asymmetry in a pigmented skin lesion is one feature associated with melanoma, particularly alongside irregular borders or varied color.

Asymptomatic

Having a disease, infection, or abnormal finding without noticeable symptoms. A person may still have detectable disease, develop complications, or transmit an infection; this differs from presymptomatic illness, in which symptoms appear later.

Asymptomatic Adults

Adults who have no noticeable symptoms of the condition being assessed. Absence of symptoms does not exclude early or hidden disease, risk factors, or the ability to transmit an infection.

Asymptomatic Bacteriuria

Bacteria detected in a properly collected urine sample when the person has no urinary symptoms. Its clinical significance differs from symptomatic urinary infection and varies in groups such as pregnant people and those undergoing urinary-tract procedures.

Asymptomatic Bacteriuria In Pregnancy

Bacteria growing in a pregnant person's urine without burning, urgency, or other urinary symptoms. It is identified by urine culture and is associated with increased risk of kidney infection and pregnancy complications.

Asymptomatic Carrier

A person who carries an infectious organism without symptoms but may still transmit it to others. Whether transmission occurs depends on the organism, body site, and contact.

Asymptomatic HIV Infection

HIV infection without noticeable symptoms at present. HIV can still multiply and gradually weaken the immune system, and the person may transmit it without effective treatment.

Asymptomatic Infections

Infections in which the person has no noticeable symptoms. The organism may still be detectable, cause later complications, or spread to others; this differs from presymptomatic infection, in which symptoms develop later.

Alternate Names:
Subclinical Infections

Asystole

Absence of effective electrical activity in the heart's lower chambers and absence of useful pumping. It causes cardiac arrest; an apparent flat ECG tracing can also result from disconnected leads or equipment failure.

Ataxia

Loss of smooth control and coordination of movement. It is a sign rather than one specific disease and may cause an unsteady walk, poor balance, clumsy movements, slurred speech, shaking, or abnormal eye movements. It can result from a problem in the cerebellum, spinal cord, sensory nerves, or balance organs and is different from muscle weakness alone. Causes include inherited disorders, stroke, multiple sclerosis, infection, vitamin deficiency, medicines, alcohol, or other toxins. The onset may be sudden or gradual, and the course depends on the cause.

Ataxia Telangiectasia

A rare autosomal-recessive DNA-repair disorder causing progressive cerebellar ataxia, telangiectasias of the eyes or skin, immune deficiency, radiosensitivity, and increased risk of leukemia, lymphoma, or other cancers. Respiratory infections and elevated alpha-fetoprotein may occur.

Alternate Names:
A-T; Ataxia-Telangiectasia

Ataxic

Characterized by ataxia, or impaired coordination of voluntary movement. An ataxic person may have an unsteady gait, irregular limb movements, or poorly coordinated speech. The term describes a clinical finding rather than its cause; the underlying problem may involve the cerebellum, sensory pathways, or balance system. It may also describe other movements with irregular timing.

Ataxic Breathing

An irregular, unpredictable pattern in which the rate and depth of breaths vary randomly. It usually indicates severe injury to the lower brainstem and may precede breathing failure.

Ataxic Cerebral Palsy

A form of cerebral palsy caused by developmental injury or malformation of the cerebellum, charac-

terized by problems with balance, depth perception, intention tremor, and an uncoordinated, wide-based gait.

Alternate Names:
Ataxic CP

Ataxic Gait

An abnormal, unsteady, and poorly coordinated walking pattern resulting from dysfunction in the motor coordination or sensory balance pathways. In cerebellar ataxia, the gait is characteristically wide-based, irregular, lurching, and clumsy, with difficulty maintaining a straight line and inability to perform tandem walking. In sensory ataxia (caused by dorsal column or peripheral proprioceptive loss), the gait is wide-based with high-stepping stamping of the feet, markedly worsening with eye closure (positive Romberg sign).

Ataxophobia

An extreme, irrational fear of disorder, untidiness, or irregularity, compelling intense distress when objects or surroundings are not perfectly arranged.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Disorder

A-T Base Pair

Pairing of adenine with thymine in double-stranded DNA through two hydrogen bonds.

Alternate Names:
Adenine-Thymine Base Pair

Atelectasis

Partial or complete collapse of a region of lung, reducing the amount of air it contains. It may result from blocked airways, pressure from outside the lung, shallow breathing, or scarring and can reduce oxygen exchange.

Alternate Names:
Lung Collapse

Atelophobia

An intense, paralyzing fear of imperfection or of making mistakes, often leading to severe performance anxiety and avoidance of tasks.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Imperfection

Athelia

Congenital absence of one or both nipples, sometimes including the areola; breast tissue may be present. It may occur alone or as part of a congenital syndrome.

Common name: Absence of the nipple

Atherectomy

A minimally invasive endovascular catheter technique utilizing directional, rotational, orbital, or laser devices to physically excise, shave, vaporize, or pulverize calcified or atheromatous plaque from the intraluminal wall of diseased arteries.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Atherectomy; Directional Atherectomy; Rotational Atherectomy; Orbital Atherectomy

Atheroembolic Renal Disease

Kidney injury caused when cholesterol crystals break from an artery plaque and block small kidney vessels, often after a vascular procedure. It may cause worsening kidney function, mottled skin, painful toes, or raised eosinophils.

Atheroma

A fatty, inflamed buildup within an artery wall that forms part of an atherosclerotic plaque. It may narrow the artery or rupture and trigger a blood clot.

Alternate Names:
Atheromatous Plaque; Arterial Plaque

Atheromatous Plaque

An asymmetrical, fibrofatty lesion developing within the tunica intima of medium and large arteries, comprising a necrotic lipid-rich core of oxidized cholesterol crystals and apoptotic debris covered by a fibrous cap of collagen and vascular smooth muscle cells.

Alternate Names:
Atheroma; Atherosclerotic Plaque

Atherosclerosis

A chronic disease of arteries in which plaques containing cholesterol, inflammatory cells, connective tissue, and often calcium build up in the inner artery wall. Plaques can gradually narrow the artery and reduce blood flow; if a plaque ruptures or erodes, a blood clot may form and suddenly block the artery. Depending on the affected artery, atherosclerosis can cause coronary artery disease, ischemic stroke, or peripheral artery disease.

Atherosclerosis of Aorta

The accumulation of lipid plaques, fibrous tissue, and calcium within the intima of the aorta, leading to hardening, loss of elasticity, and luminal irregularity, which can serve as a source of distal thromboembolism or aortic aneurysm formation.

Alternate Names:
Aortic Atherosclerosis; Aortic Atheroma

Atherosclerosis Pathology

A chronic arterial intimal disease characterized by lipid-rich plaques with a fibrous cap, inflammation, smooth-muscle proliferation, calcification, and possible ulceration or thrombosis.

Atherosclerotic

Relating to fatty plaque buildup and hardening inside artery walls. Atherosclerotic changes can narrow an artery or encourage a clot to form.

Atherosclerotic Heart Disease

A disease in which cholesterol-containing plaque builds up inside the heart's arteries, narrowing them and reducing blood flow. It may cause chest pain, heart attack, or other heart problems.

Atherosclerotic Plaque

A buildup of cholesterol, fat, inflammatory cells, and scar-like tissue inside an artery wall. It can gradually narrow the artery or rupture and cause a blood clot.

Atherothrombotic Stroke

An ischemic stroke caused by a clot forming on fatty plaque in a large artery supplying the brain or travelling from that plaque into a brain artery. It deprives brain tissue of oxygen.

Alternate Names:
Large-Artery Atherosclerotic Stroke; Atherothrombotic Ischemic Stroke

Athetoid Cerebral Palsy

A dyskinetic subtype of cerebral palsy resulting from injury to the basal ganglia during early brain development, characterized by involuntary, slow, writhing movements of the limbs, trunk, and face, often fluctuating in muscle tone.

Alternate Names:
Dyskinetic Cerebral Palsy; Choreoathetoid Cerebral Palsy

Athetosis

Slow, involuntary, writhing movements that may affect the hands, fingers, feet, face, neck, or trunk. They result from abnormal function in brain areas that help control movement and may occur with inherited or acquired brain injury.

Athlete Foot

Alternate name; see *Athlete's Foot*.

Athlete's Foot

A common superficial fungal infection (dermatophytosis) of the skin of the feet, most commonly caused by *Trichophyton rubrum* or *Trichophyton interdigitale*. Classically presents with pruritus, erythema, scaling, maceration, and fissuring, especially in the interdigital web spaces.

Alternate Names:
Tinea Pedis; Foot Ringworm; Foot Dermatophytosis

Athlete's Heart

Normal physiological cardiac remodeling induced by intensive, prolonged physical endurance or strength training, manifested as physiological left ventricular hypertrophy, chamber dilation, and resting sinus bradycardia, without diastolic dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Athletic Heart Syndrome; Athlete Heart Remodel-

ing

At-Home COVID-19 Testing

At-home testing for COVID-19 commonly uses a rapid antigen test from a nasal sample. A negative result may occur early in infection despite the presence of SARS-CoV-2.

Atlantoaxial Instability

Excessive movement between the first and second cervical vertebrae, sometimes caused by trauma, rheumatoid arthritis, congenital conditions, or ligament weakness. It may cause neck pain, occipital headache, neurologic symptoms, or spinal-cord compression.

Atlantoaxial Instability in Down Syndrome

Excessive movement between the first and second cervical vertebrae in a person with Down syndrome, often related to ligament laxity or altered bone development. Many people have no symptoms; instability may cause neck pain, weakness, gait change, or spinal-cord signs, particularly with neck movement.

Atlantoaxial Joint

The complex synovial articulation between the first cervical vertebra (atlas, C1) and the second cervical vertebra (axis, C2). Comprising one median pivot joint (dens with anterior arch) and two lateral facet joints, it provides approximately 50% of total cervical rotational range of motion. Instability may arise from trauma (odontoid fractures), rheumatoid arthritis, or Down syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Atlas-Axis Joint; C1-C2 Articulation

Atlanto-Occipital Dislocation

A severe injury in which the first neck bone separates from the base of the skull. It is extremely unstable and can damage the spinal cord or brainstem, causing paralysis, respiratory failure, or death.

Atlanto-Occipital Joints

The paired joints between the upper surface of the atlas, the first cervical vertebra, and the occipital condyles at the base of the skull. They mainly allow nodding and small side-to-side movements while helping stabilize the head and upper neck.

Atlas

The first bone of the neck, supporting the skull and helping the head nod. It is ring-shaped and has openings through which important blood vessels pass.

Atom

The smallest unit of a chemical element that retains the element's properties. It contains a central nucleus surrounded by electrons.

Atonic

Lacking normal muscle tone or ability to contract. For example, an atonic bladder does not squeeze effectively to empty urine.

Atonic Seizure

A seizure causing sudden loss of muscle tone, often for only a few seconds. The person may drop their head, knees, or whole body and fall; injuries can occur during the fall.

Atopic

Having a tendency to develop allergic conditions such as eczema, allergic rhinitis, or asthma. This tendency may run in families and reflects increased sensitivity of the immune system.

Atopic Dermatitis

A chronic, relapsing, intensely itchy inflammatory skin disease involving epidermal-barrier dysfunction and immune dysregulation. It causes dry, inflamed, scaly, or lichenified lesions whose distribution varies with age; scratching can produce infection, excoriations, and sleep disturbance.

Alternate Names:
Atopic Eczema

Atopic Eruption Of Pregnancy

An itchy eczema-like rash that begins or worsens during pregnancy, often on the face, neck, chest, or

skin folds. It usually improves after delivery and is not harmful to the fetus.

Atopic Rhinitis

Allergy-related inflammation inside the nose. Exposure to pollen, dust mites, mould, animals, or other triggers can cause sneezing, itching, a blocked or runny nose, and reduced smell.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Rhinitis

Atopy

A tendency to develop certain allergies, influenced by genes and the environment. These may include hay fever, asthma, eczema, or some food allergies. Atopy is not an allergy itself, and having this tendency does not mean a person will develop these conditions.

Atorvastatin

A medicine that lowers low-density lipoprotein cholesterol by reducing cholesterol production in the liver. It lowers the risk of heart attack and stroke in appropriate people; muscle symptoms and liver problems are uncommon but important side effects.

Atovaquone–Proguanil

A combination of medicines used to prevent or treat some forms of malaria. The medicines interfere with energy production and folate use in malaria parasites; suitability depends on the type of malaria and the person's health.

ATP

Adenosine triphosphate, the main short-term energy-carrying molecule in cells. Cells release usable energy when ATP is broken down and remake it during metabolism.

ATP Synthase

A protein machine in mitochondria and some other cell membranes that uses the movement of hydrogen ions to make ATP, the main molecule cells use for immediate energy.

Atransferrinemia

A very rare inherited disorder in which the blood has little or no transferrin, the protein that carries iron. It can cause severe anemia, poor growth, and harmful iron buildup in organs.

Atresia

A birth defect in which a normal opening or passage is absent, closed, or severely narrowed. Examples include intestinal, bile-duct, heart-valve, and ear-canal atresia; effects depend on the structure involved.

Atresia Of Bile Ducts

See *Biliary Atresia*.

Atretic Cephalocele

A small, skin-covered congenital scalp nodule formed from a regressed cephalocele, usually near the midline at the parietal or occipital scalp. It may connect through a small skull defect to the dura by a fibrous stalk and can be associated with abnormal development of brain tissue or intracranial veins.

Atria

The two upper chambers of the heart. The right atrium receives blood from the body and the left atrium receives blood from the lungs; each passes blood to the lower pumping chamber on its side.

Atrial

Relating to either of the heart's two upper chambers, which receive blood and pass it to the lower pumping chambers.

Atrial Ablation

A procedure, usually catheter-based, that uses heat, cold, or another form of energy to make small areas of scar in heart tissue responsible for an abnormal atrial rhythm. The scars block unwanted electrical signals.

Atrial Arrhythmia

An abnormal heart rhythm that begins in one of the heart's upper chambers. It may cause palpitations, breathlessness, dizziness, chest discomfort, or faint-

ing; examples include atrial fibrillation and atrial flutter.

Atrial Dyssynchrony

Poorly coordinated timing of electrical activation or contraction between the right and left atria, often related to delayed interatrial conduction. It can impair coordinated atrial emptying and timing between atrial and ventricular contraction.

Atrial Fib

Alternate name; see *Atrial Fibrillation*.

Atrial Fibrillation

An abnormal heart rhythm in which the heart's upper chambers (atria) beat chaotically instead of contracting in an organized way. The heartbeat is often irregular and may be fast, but some people have no symptoms. Blood may pool in the atria and form clots, increasing the risk of stroke.

Alternate Names:
AF; AFib; Auricular Fibrillation

Atrial Fibrillation Ablation

A catheter procedure that creates small scars, usually around the pulmonary veins, to block electrical signals that trigger atrial fibrillation. It may reduce symptoms, but recurrence and procedure-related risks remain possible.

Atrial Fibrillation Medicines

Medicines used for atrial fibrillation may slow the heart rate, restore or maintain a regular rhythm, or reduce stroke risk by preventing clots. Choice depends on symptoms, heart structure, kidney function, bleeding risk, and other conditions.

Atrial Fibrillation With RVR

A clinical presentation of atrial fibrillation in which the rapid, chaotic atrial electrical impulses conduct frequently through the atrioventricular node, producing an irregularly irregular ventricular response with a ventricular rate exceeding 100 beats per minute at rest.

Alternate Names:
AFib with Rapid Ventricular Response; Rapid Atrial Fibrillation

Atrial Flutter

An abnormal heart rhythm caused by a fast, repeating electrical signal in the heart's upper chambers. The heartbeat may be rapid or irregular, and some people have palpitations, tiredness, dizziness, or no symptoms. Atrial flutter can allow blood clots to form and raise the risk of stroke.

Alternate Names:
AFlutter

Atrial Myxoma

A usually noncancerous tumour arising inside the heart, most often in the left atrium. It may obstruct blood flow, cause breathlessness or fainting, or release fragments that block blood vessels.

Atrial Natriuretic Peptide

A hormone released by the heart's upper chambers when they stretch from extra blood. It tells the kidneys to remove more salt and water and helps relax blood vessels, lowering blood volume and pressure.

Atrial Pseudomasses

Normal atrial structures, anatomic variants, or imaging artifacts that resemble a tumour or clot on cardiac imaging. Examples include a prominent crista terminalis, Chiari network, Eustachian valve, and Coumadin ridge.

Atrial Septal Aneurysm

A localized, mobile saccular deformity or pouching of the interatrial septum, typically protruding greater than 10 to 15 millimeters into either the right or left atrium during the cardiac cycle, often coexisting with a patent foramen ovale.

Alternate Names:
ASA (Cardiology)

Atrial Septal Defect

An opening in the wall between the heart's two upper chambers, present from birth. Blood usually flows through it from the left side to the right,

sending extra blood to the lungs and the right side of the heart. Small secundum defects may close on their own or cause no symptoms; a significant shunt can enlarge the right side of the heart, disturb its rhythm, or raise pressure in the lung blood vessels. Unlike a patent foramen ovale, a flap-like opening that may stay open after birth, an atrial septal defect involves a deficiency in the septum.

Atrial Septum

The wall separating the heart's right and left upper chambers. A hole in this wall is called an atrial septal defect.

Atrial Standstill

Failure of the heart's upper chambers to produce normal electrical signals or contractions. It can cause a very slow heartbeat, dizziness, fainting, poor circulation, or heart failure.

Atrial Switch Operation

An older operation for transposition of the major heart arteries that redirects blood inside the atria using a tunnel-like passage. The Mustard and Senning procedures are its principal forms. It restores circulation but leaves the right pumping chamber supporting the body and may cause later rhythm or heart-muscle problems.

Atrial Tachycardia

A fast heart rhythm that starts in an area of an upper chamber outside the normal pacemaker. It may cause palpitations, breathlessness, dizziness, chest discomfort, or fainting.

Atrial Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot inside one of the heart's upper chambers, especially during atrial fibrillation. The clot can break loose and block blood flow to the brain or another organ.

Atrioventricular

Relating to the connection between a heart's upper chamber and the lower chamber on the same side. The term includes the mitral and tricuspid valves and the electrical pathway that coordinates the timing of their contractions.

Atrioventricular Block

Delayed or interrupted electrical signals between the heart's upper and lower chambers. It may cause a slow heartbeat, tiredness, dizziness, fainting, or no symptoms; severe block can impair cardiac output and may require pacing.

Atrioventricular Bundle

A bundle of specialized electrical fibers that carries signals from the heart's central relay point into the lower chambers. Its branches help both pumping chambers contract in a coordinated way.

Alternate Names:
Bundle of His

Atrioventricular Canal Defect

Alternate name; see *Atrioventricular Septal Defect*.

Atrioventricular Dissociation

A cardiac rhythm abnormality in which the atria and ventricles depolarize and contract independently under the control of separate pacemakers, occurring when ventricular pacing is faster than atrial rate or during complete atrioventricular block.

Alternate Names:
AV Dissociation

Atrioventricular Nodal Reentrant Tachycardia

A sudden, regular, fast heartbeat caused by an electrical loop near the heart's central relay point. Episodes may cause pounding heartbeat, chest discomfort, breathlessness, dizziness, or fainting and may stop as suddenly as they begin.

Alternate Names:
AV Nodal Reentrant Tachycardia; AVNRT

Atrioventricular Nodal Reentry Tachycardia

A rapid, regular heartbeat caused by a looping electrical signal near the atrioventricular node. It commonly begins and ends suddenly and may cause palpitations, dizziness, breathlessness, or fainting.

Atrioventricular Node

A small area of specialized tissue near the junction of the heart's upper and lower chambers that receives electrical signals and briefly delays them before passing them to the lower chambers. This delay allows the upper chambers to empty first.

Atrioventricular Septal Defect

A spectrum of congenital heart defects involving abnormal development of the central heart septa and atrioventricular valves. Complete forms include defects in both the atrial and ventricular septa and a common atrioventricular valve; partial forms usually include an atrial septal defect without a ventricular septal defect and have separate valve openings, often with leakage through the left atrioventricular valve. Abnormal blood flow may cause heart failure or increased pressure in the lung arteries.

Alternate Names:
AVSD; Atrioventricular Canal Defect; Endocardial Cushion Defect

Atrioventricular Valves

The two heart valves between the upper and lower chambers: the tricuspid valve on the right and the mitral valve on the left. They open to let blood pass forward and close to prevent backflow.

Atrium

One of the heart's two upper chambers, which receive returning blood and pass it to the lower pumping chambers. The right atrium receives blood from the body; the left receives oxygen-rich blood from the lungs.

Atrophic Gastritis

See *Chronic Atrophic Gastritis*.

Atrophic Glossitis

Loss of the tongue's tiny surface projections, leaving it smooth and often red. The finding may be associated with iron, vitamin B12, or folate deficiency, or with conditions such as celiac disease. It describes a clinical finding rather than a single cause or disease. Specific names such as Hunter glossitis refer to deficiency-related forms rather than all atrophic glossitis.

Atrophic Kidney

A kidney that has become significantly smaller than normal and lost functioning parenchymal tissue, resulting from chronic ischemia (such as renal artery stenosis), recurrent infection (chronic pyelonephritis), or reflux nephropathy.

Alternate Names:
Small Kidney; Renal Atrophy

Atrophic Rhinitis

A chronic disease of the nasal cavity characterized by progressive atrophy of the nasal mucosa and underlying turbinate bone, accompanied by widening of the nasal passages, formation of foul-smelling crusts (ozena), and impaired sense of smell.

Atrophic Vaginitis

Alternate name; see *Vaginal Atrophy*.

Aerobic Vaginitis

Inflammation of the vagina in which protective lactobacilli decrease and other bacteria increase. It may cause yellow discharge, burning, or redness. Unlike bacterial vaginosis, it usually includes visible inflammation.

Allergic Vaginitis

Vaginal irritation caused by an allergic reaction to a substance that contacts vaginal or vulvar tissue, such as a medicine, lubricant, or latex. It is related to allergic contact dermatitis and differs from irritation caused by direct chemical injury.

Atrophoderma Maculatum

A rare skin condition causing flat, slightly sunken patches in which the skin becomes thinner and changes colour. The patches usually have no open sore or active infection.

Atrophy

Shrinkage and loss of function of a tissue, organ, or muscle because its cells become smaller or fewer. Causes include disuse, nerve damage, poor blood

supply, malnutrition, hormone deficiency, chronic disease, and ageing; it may be partly reversible.

Atropine

A medicine that blocks acetylcholine signals at certain nerve endings. It can increase heart rate, reduce secretions, widen the pupils, and counteract selected poisonings or dangerously slow heartbeats.

Atropine In Organophosphate Poisoning

A medicine used in organophosphate poisoning to block excessive acetylcholine effects, including wet secretions, narrowed airways, slow heartbeat, vomiting, and diarrhoea. It is used with other measures to treat cholinergic toxicity.

Attachment Disorder

See *Reactive Attachment Disorder*.

Attack Rate

The proportion of people at risk who develop a particular illness during a defined outbreak or exposure period. It is commonly used to describe foodborne outbreaks and other limited events.

Attention

The ability to select information, focus on it, and maintain that focus while limiting distraction. Attention can be affected by sleep loss, stress, illness, medicines, or brain disorders.

Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder

Alternate index label; see *Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder*.

Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder

A neurodevelopmental disorder involving persistent inattention, hyperactivity, and impulsive behaviour that affects functioning or development. Presentations may be mainly inattentive, mainly hyperactive-impulsive, or combined.

Alternate Names:
ADHD; Hyperkinetic Disorder

Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD)

Alternate name; see *Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder*.

Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder in Adults

The persistence of ADHD into adulthood, characterized by persistent patterns of inattention, executive dysfunction, disorganization, impulsivity, and emotional restlessness that interfere with occupational, social, and academic functioning.

Alternate Names:
Adult ADHD; Adult Attention-Deficit Disorder

Attenuated

Weakened or reduced in force, severity, concentration, or biological activity. An attenuated vaccine contains a weakened form of a microorganism that is intended to stimulate immunity without usually causing disease.

Attenuation Correction

A computer adjustment for the way body tissues weaken signals during medical imaging. It helps make PET, SPECT, and combined scan images more accurate by compensating for signal loss.

ATTR-CM

A progressive disease of the heart muscle caused by the abnormal clumping and buildup of misfolded transthyretin proteins in the heart walls. This protein accumulation stiffens the heart ventricles, reducing their ability to relax and pump blood effectively, resulting in heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Transthyretin Amyloid Cardiomyopathy; Transthyretin Cardiac Amyloidosis

Attributable Risk

The difference in disease risk between people exposed and not exposed to a possible cause. It estimates the extra risk associated with the exposure, but does not by itself prove causation.

Atychiphobia

An irrational and overwhelming fear of failure, causing avoidance of tasks, personal goals, or career pursuits due to anticipatory anxiety over falling short.

Alternate Names:
Fear of Failure

Atypia

An abnormal appearance of cells or tissue under a microscope, such as unusual cell size, shape, or organization. It is a descriptive finding, not a diagnosis by itself; it can occur with inflammation or repair, precancerous changes, or cancer. Pathologists interpret it according to the tissue involved and the degree of change.

Atypia Morphology

Microscopic cell or tissue features that differ from the expected pattern, such as variation in cell size or shape, irregular nuclei, or disorganized tissue structure. These changes may be reactive, precancerous, or cancerous; atypia alone does not establish cancer.

Alternate Names:
Cytologic Atypia

Atypical

Different from the usual appearance, behaviour, structure, or course of a condition. Atypical does not by itself mean that a finding is harmless, precancerous, or cancerous.

Atypical Anorexia

An eating disorder in which an individual exhibits all the cognitive and behavioral diagnostic features of anorexia nervosa—including intense fear of gaining weight, severe dietary restriction, and distorted body image—despite maintaining a body weight within or above the normal range.

Alternate Names:
Atypical Anorexia Nervosa

Atypical Antipsychotics

A group of medicines used mainly for schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and selected other conditions. They change several brain signals and can cause sleepiness, weight gain, movement problems, high blood sugar, or other metabolic changes.

Atypical Depression

A specifier for a depressive episode in which mood temporarily improves in response to positive events, with at least two of the following: increased appetite or weight, increased sleep, a heavy feeling in the arms or legs (leaden paralysis), or marked sensitivity to rejection. It can be applied to major depressive disorder or persistent depressive disorder.

Alternate Names:
Major Depression with Atypical Features; Depression with Atypical Features

Atypical Ductal Hyperplasia

A benign breast condition in which more than the usual number of abnormal-looking cells grow within breast ducts. It is not cancer, but it is associated with an increased risk of developing breast cancer.

Atypical (Dysplastic) Nevus

A melanocytic mole with unusual clinical or microscopic features such as asymmetry, irregular border, varied color, or larger size. Most are benign, but multiple atypical nevi increase melanoma risk; a changing, bleeding, or distinctly different lesion may resemble melanoma.

Atypical Endometrial Hyperplasia

An overgrowth of abnormal cells in the lining of the uterus. It is not cancer, but it can develop into uterine-lining cancer or occur alongside it.

Atypical Facial Pain

Persistent or recurring pain in the face that does not fit a clear nerve, dental, sinus, or other recognized cause. Evaluation looks for treatable causes before considering persistent facial-pain disorders.

Atypical Features

A depressive-disorder specifier defined by mood reactivity plus at least two associated features; see *Atypical Depression*.

Atypical Fibroxanthoma

An uncommon, usually superficial skin tumor that appears as a rapidly growing red or pink nodule on sun-damaged skin, often on the head or neck of an older adult. Tissue examination distinguishes it from similar skin cancers and from pleomorphic dermal sarcoma, which extends into deeper tissues.

Atypical Genitalia

A term describing external genital anatomy that does not fit typical male or female patterns. It may reflect differences in chromosomal, gonadal, hormonal, or genital development and can occur alone or with other variations in sex characteristics.

Atypical Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome

A rare disease in which inherited or acquired abnormalities of the complement system cause uncontrolled immune activity and damage to small blood vessels, especially in the kidneys. It can destroy red blood cells, lower platelets, and cause sudden kidney injury, high blood pressure, or neurological problems. Unlike typical hemolytic uremic syndrome, it is not primarily caused by a toxin-producing diarrheal infection.

Alternate Names:
aHUS; Complement-Mediated HUS

Atypical Hyperplasia Of The Breast

A group of benign breast lesions with abnormal cells in the ducts or lobules. Atypical ductal hyperplasia and atypical lobular hyperplasia are distinct types; both are associated with an increased risk of breast cancer.

Atypical Lobular Hyperplasia

A benign breast condition in which more than the usual number of abnormal-looking cells grow in the milk-producing lobules. It is not cancer, but it is associated with an increased risk of developing breast cancer.

Atypical Lymphocyte

A lymphocyte, a type of white blood cell, with an unusual size or appearance under a microscope. It often reflects immune activity during a viral infection, but the finding alone does not identify a specific disease.

Atypical Mole

A mole with unusual clinical features, sometimes called an atypical nevus. The term *dysplastic nevus* is often used for such moles but may specifically refer to microscopic findings, so the terms are not always interchangeable. Most are noncancerous, although multiple atypical moles can increase melanoma risk and atypical features can overlap with melanoma.

Atypical Nevi

Alternate plural name; see *Atypical Mole*.

Atypical Pneumonia

A lung infection that often develops gradually and may cause more general symptoms than chest symptoms, such as headache, tiredness, sore throat, or muscle aches. Causes include certain bacteria and viruses.

Atypical Spitz Nevus

An unusual mole made of pigment-producing cells that resembles a Spitz nevus but has concerning features. Its microscopic appearance can resemble melanoma.

Atypical Teratoid Rhabdoid Tumor

A rare, fast-growing cancer of the brain or spinal cord that occurs mainly in infants and young children. It may cause vomiting, headache, sleepiness, balance problems, seizures, or developmental changes.

Alternate Names:
ATRT; Rhabdoid Brain Tumor

Audiogram

A chart that shows a person's ability to hear at different pitches or frequencies.

Audiologist

A health professional who assesses hearing and fits hearing aids.

Audiology

The healthcare field concerned with hearing, balance, and related communication problems. Audiologists test hearing and balance, provide hearing aids and other devices, offer training and support, and identify when medical or surgical care may be needed.

Audiometry

Measurement of hearing sensitivity at different sound frequencies and intensities, usually using headphones or insert earphones.

Auditory Acuity

The sensitivity or sharpness of hearing, commonly assessed by determining the softest sounds a person can detect at different frequencies.

Auditory Area

A group of sound-processing regions in the temporal lobe. The primary auditory cortex, on the superior temporal gyrus, processes basic sound features; surrounding auditory association areas help interpret more complex sounds, including speech.

Alternate Names:
Auditory Cortex

Auditory Fatigue

A temporary decrease in hearing sensitivity or listening ability after prolonged loud sound exposure; rest usually helps, but repeated exposure can cause lasting damage.

Auditory Hallucinations

False sensory perceptions of sound occurring in the absence of any external acoustic stimulus. They may be non-verbal (such as clicks, ringing, or music) or verbal (such as single words, conversations, running commentary, or command voices). Verbal auditory hallucinations are a hallmark feature of psychotic disorders such as schizophrenia, but can also occur in severe mood disorders with psychotic features, delirium, temporal lobe epilepsy, sensory deprivation, and substance withdrawal.

Alternate Names:
Paracusia; Phonemes; Auditory Sensory Hallucinations

Auditory Information Processing Disorder

See *Auditory Processing Disorder*.

Auditory Nerve

The portion of the vestibulocochlear nerve that carries hearing signals from the inner ear to the brain.

Auditory Neuropathy Spectrum Disorder

A form of sensorineural hearing impairment characterized by preserved cochlear outer hair cell function (demonstrated by normal otoacoustic emissions or cochlear microphonics) but abnormal, dyssynchronous neural transmission along the eighth cranial nerve.

Alternate Names:
ANSD; Auditory Neuropathy

Auditory Ossicle

One of three small middle-ear bones—the malleus, incus, and stapes—that transmit and amplify vibrations from the eardrum to the inner ear. Disease, injury, or fixation of these bones can cause conductive hearing loss.

Alternate Names:
Ear Ossicle

Auditory Pathway

A chain of nerve structures carrying sound signals from the inner ear through the brainstem to the auditory cortex for recognition and interpretation.

Auditory Perception

The brain's process of detecting, recognizing, and interpreting sounds received through the auditory system.

Auditory Processing Disorder

Difficulty recognizing or interpreting spoken sounds despite normal or near-normal basic hearing sensitivity. A person may struggle to understand speech in noise, follow rapid speech, or distinguish similar sounds. It may coexist with language, attention, or

learning differences.

Alternate Names:
APD

Auditory Threshold

The quietest sound a person can hear at a particular pitch or frequency. It is measured during a hearing test and helps describe the degree and type of hearing loss in each ear.

Alternate Names:
Hearing Threshold

Auerbach Plexus

An extensive intrinsic neural network of unmyelinated nerve fibers and postganglionic parasympathetic ganglia situated in the muscularis externa between the circular and longitudinal smooth muscle layers throughout the gastrointestinal tract, coordinating peristalsis and motor activity.

Alternate Names:
Myenteric Plexus

Auer Rods

Needle-shaped structures sometimes seen inside immature blood cells under a microscope. They are made from fused cell granules and strongly suggest a cancer of immature myeloid blood cells, especially acute myeloid leukemia.

Auger Electrons

Very low-energy electrons released by some radioactive atoms after a change inside the atom. They travel only a tiny distance and can damage nearby DNA, a property being studied for precisely targeted radiation treatment.

Augmentation Mammaplasty

Surgical enlargement or reshaping of the breasts, typically performed using prosthetic implants (saline or silicone) or autologous fat grafting.

Alternate Names:
Breast Augmentation; Augmentation Mammoplasty

Augmentation Mammoplasty

Alternate spelling; see *Augmentation Mammaplasty*.

Augmentation Of Labor

A procedure to increase the strength or frequency of contractions after labor has begun but is progressing slowly. It may involve oxytocin or artificial rupture of the amniotic membranes.

Aura

A temporary change in vision, sensation, speech, movement, or awareness that may occur before or during a migraine or seizure. Symptoms usually develop gradually and then resolve; a first or prolonged episode may have causes other than migraine.

Aural Fullness

A feeling of pressure, blockage, or fullness in the ear. It can result from poor pressure equalization, fluid, earwax, inner-ear disease, or jaw-joint problems and may occur with hearing loss, ringing, or dizziness.

Alternate Names:
Ear Pressure; Plugged-Ear Sensation; Blocked-Ear Sensation

Aural Polyps

Soft, abnormal tissue growths in the ear canal or middle ear. They often result from long-lasting infection or inflammation; persistent discharge, pain, or bleeding can occur with more serious disease.

Auricle

The visible outer part of the ear attached to the side of the head. Its ridges collect and direct sound into the ear canal, helping the brain judge where sounds come from.

Auricular Cellulitis

A bacterial infection of the skin and soft tissue of the outer ear. The ear may become red, warm, swollen, and painful, sometimes after a scratch, bite, or piercing.

Auricular Hematoma

A collection of blood between the cartilage and skin of the outer ear, usually after a blow or sports injury. It can cause lasting thickening and deformity if the blood is not drained.

Alternate Names:
Pinna Hematoma; Subperichondrial Auricular Hematoma

Auscultation

Listening to sounds produced inside the body, usually with a stethoscope. Clinicians use it to assess the heart, lungs, abdomen, and blood vessels for findings such as murmurs, wheezing, crackles, or abnormal blood-flow sounds.

Auscultatory Gap

A temporary disappearance of the sounds heard while a blood-pressure cuff is slowly deflated, followed by their return. If it is missed, the top blood-pressure number may be recorded falsely low.

Auspitz Sign

A skin check for psoriasis where tiny pinpoint bleeding spots appear when the silvery scales of a rash are gently scraped away.

Austin Flint Murmur

A low-pitched sound heard during the middle part of the heartbeat over the heart's apex. It is associated with severe leakage of the aortic valve and altered filling of the mitral valve.

Autism

Alternate name; see *Autism Spectrum Disorder*.

Autism Spectrum Disorder

A lifelong condition that can affect communication, social interaction, and how a person responds to change, repeated actions, strong interests, or sensory experiences. It begins during development but may be recognized later. Autistic people vary widely in their strengths and support needs.

Alternate Names:
ASD; Autistic Spectrum Disorder

Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)

Alternate name; see *Autism Spectrum Disorder*.

Autistic Savant

An autistic person with an unusually strong, specific ability—such as music, art, calculation, or memory—compared with their other abilities. The term describes a pattern of skills and is not itself a medical diagnosis.

Autoantibodies

Immune proteins that mistakenly recognize and attach to the body's own cells, tissues, or proteins. They may cause disease or serve as test clues; their presence alone does not prove that a person has an autoimmune disease.

Autoantibody

An immune protein that mistakenly recognizes and binds a substance from the person's own body. It may damage tissues or interfere with their function, or it may be present only as a laboratory sign without causing disease.

Autoantigen

A substance normally found in the body that is mistakenly recognized as foreign by the immune system. This mistaken response can lead to inflammation or damage to the person's own cells or tissues.

Auto-Brewery Syndrome

A rare condition in which microbes in the digestive tract are thought to ferment dietary carbohydrates and produce enough ethanol to cause intoxication without alcohol consumption. Published evidence is limited, and diagnosis requires careful exclusion of other causes.

Alternate Names:
Gut Fermentation Syndrome; Endogenous Ethanol Production

Autoclave

A machine that sterilizes equipment by exposing it to pressurized steam at a controlled temperature and time. It destroys bacteria, viruses, fungi, and spores when the correct cycle is used.

Autocrine Signaling

A mode of intercellular and intracellular communication in which a cell synthesizes and secretes a messenger molecule (such as a cytokine, hormone, or growth factor) that binds to surface receptors on the very same cell that produced it, initiating a feedback response.

Autoerythrocyte Sensitivity

A rare condition causing painful bruises or raised purple patches, historically attributed to an abnormal reaction to a person's own red-cell components. Its cause remains uncertain, and the findings can resemble other bruising disorders.

Autogenic Drainage

A controlled-breathing method that moves mucus from the smaller airways toward the throat so it can be coughed out. It uses different breathing depths and requires instruction and practice.

Autograft

Tissue moved from one part of a person's body to another part of the same body. Because the tissue is genetically the person's own, rejection is unlikely, but the original site may have pain, scarring, or other complications.

Autoimmune

Describing an immune response that mistakenly targets the body's own cells, tissues, or proteins. It can cause inflammation, tissue damage, or impaired organ function.

Autoimmune Associated Epilepsy

See *Autoimmune Epilepsy*.

Autoimmune Autonomic Ganglionopathy

A rare, severe autoimmune disorder of the autonomic nervous system characterized by widespread sympathetic and parasympathetic failure. Manifests clinically with severe orthostatic hypotension, anhidrosis, dry mouth and eyes, tonic pupils, gastrointestinal dysmotility (gastroparesis, intestinal pseudo-obstruction), and urinary retention; strongly associated with autoantibodies directed against the ganglionic nicotinic acetylcholine receptor ($\alpha_3\beta_4$ subtype).

Alternate Names:
AAG; Subacute Autonomic Neuropathy

Autoimmune Disease

A pathological condition in which the immune system mounts an aberrant adaptive immune response against the body's own autoantigens, leading to chronic inflammation, tissue destruction, and organ dysfunction. Examples include systemic lupus erythematosus, rheumatoid arthritis, Hashimoto thyroiditis, and type 1 diabetes mellitus.

Alternate Names:
Autoimmune Disorder; Autoimmune Condition

Autoimmune Diseases

Plural form; see *Autoimmune Disease*.

Autoimmune Disorder

Alternate name; see *Autoimmune Disease*.

Autoimmune Encephalitis

Inflammation of the brain caused by an immune attack on nerve cells or their proteins. It may cause seizures, confusion, memory problems, unusual movements, behaviour changes, sleep problems, or reduced consciousness.

Autoimmune Encephalopathy

See *Autoimmune Encephalitis*.

Autoimmune Endocrine Disease

An autoimmune disorder that damages a hormone-producing gland or hormone-producing cells. Examples include autoimmune thyroid disease, Addison disease, and type 1 diabetes; it may cause too little or, less often, abnormal hormone production.

Autoimmune Enteropathy

A rare disease in which the immune system damages the lining of the small intestine, causing ongoing diarrhoea, poor nutrient absorption, weight loss, or growth problems. It may occur with other immune disorders.

Autoimmune Epilepsy

Recurrent seizures caused by an immune attack on the brain. Seizures may begin suddenly or be difficult to control and can occur with memory problems, confusion, movement changes, or other signs of brain inflammation.

Autoimmune Gastritis

Long-term inflammation that damages acid- and vitamin-B12-producing cells in the stomach. It can cause low stomach acid, iron deficiency, vitamin B12 deficiency, anaemia, digestive symptoms, and an increased risk of certain stomach growths.

Autoimmune Hemolytic Anemia

Anemia caused when the immune system mistakenly makes antibodies that destroy red blood cells faster than the body can replace them. It may cause tiredness, pale or yellow skin, dark urine, a fast heartbeat, or shortness of breath.

Autoimmune Hepatitis

Long-term liver inflammation caused by an immune attack on liver cells. It may cause tiredness, nausea, joint pain, or jaundice, while some people have no symptoms; untreated disease can lead to scarring and liver failure.

Autoimmune Inner Ear Disease

A rare inflammatory condition characterized by rapidly progressive, bilateral sensorineural hearing loss that develops over weeks to months, caused by autoimmune attack against inner ear antigens, often accompanied by tinnitus and vertigo.

Alternate Names:
AIED

Autoimmune Keratitis

Inflammation of the clear front surface of the eye caused by or associated with immune disease. It may cause eye pain, redness, light sensitivity, blurred vision, or a corneal scar.

Autoimmune Liver Disease Panel

A group of blood tests that looks for immune proteins linked with autoimmune liver diseases. Results are interpreted with liver tests, symptoms, examination, and sometimes a liver biopsy; the panel alone cannot establish a diagnosis.

Autoimmune Lymphoproliferative Syndrome

An inherited immune disorder in which lymphocytes do not die off normally after an immune response, causing noncancerous enlargement of lymph nodes and spleen from early childhood. Autoimmune destruction of blood cells may cause anemia, low platelets, or low white-cell counts. It is often due to a defect in the Fas cell-death pathway; diagnosis uses blood counts, specialized immune-cell testing, and gene testing, and there is an increased risk of lymphoma.

Autoimmune Neutropenia

A hematologic disorder caused by the production of autoantibodies directed against specific antigens on mature neutrophils, accelerating their destruction and leading to low absolute neutrophil counts and increased susceptibility to bacterial infections.

Alternate Names:
AIN (Hematology)

Autoimmune Pancreatitis

A rare form of pancreas inflammation caused by an abnormal immune response. It may cause painless jaundice, abdominal pain, weight loss, or a mass that resembles cancer and often improves with immune-suppressing treatment.

Autoimmune Polyendocrine Syndromes

A group of inherited or acquired disorders in which immune attacks affect several hormone-producing glands. Depending on the type, features may include adrenal failure, low parathyroid hormone, thyroid disease, diabetes, chronic fungal infection, or skin changes.

Autoimmune Polyendocrinopathy

A disorder in which immune attacks affect several hormone-producing glands. One inherited form can cause chronic fungal infections of skin or mouth,

low parathyroid hormone, adrenal failure, and other autoimmune conditions.

Autoimmune Polyglandular Syndrome

A group of disorders in which the immune system damages two or more hormone-producing glands. Possible effects include adrenal failure, thyroid disease, low parathyroid hormone, diabetes, or problems with reproductive hormones.

Autoimmune Thyroid Disease and Pregnancy

Thyroid autoimmunity can cause hypothyroidism, hyperthyroidism, pregnancy loss, preterm birth, or fetal thyroid effects. Thyroid function and medicine doses are monitored closely before and during pregnancy and after delivery.

Autoimmune Thyroiditis

Immune-mediated inflammation and damage of the thyroid gland. See *Hashimoto Thyroiditis*.

Autoimmunity

An immune response directed against the body's own cells, tissues, or proteins. It may cause no harm, or it may produce inflammation and disease when it damages tissues or interferes with organ function.

Autoimmunity: Mechanisms

Autoimmunity can develop when the immune system fails to remove or control self-reactive cells, or when an infection triggers responses that also recognize body tissues. Genetic factors, immune regulation, and environmental triggers may all contribute.

Autoinflammatory Diseases

Conditions in which the body's early, nonspecific immune response becomes overactive and causes repeated or ongoing inflammation. They may cause fever, rash, joint pain, abdominal pain, or organ damage, often without disease-specific autoantibodies.

Autoinoculation

The spread of an infection from one part of a person's body to another, often by touching or scratching. This can transfer germs to broken skin, the eyes, the mouth, or another vulnerable site.

Autologous

Taken from and returned to the same person. Examples include storing a person's own blood for later transfusion or collecting and returning their own stem cells during treatment.

Autologous Blood Donation

Collection and storage of a person's own blood before an operation for possible transfusion during or after surgery. It avoids incompatibility with donor blood but may not be suitable or necessary for everyone.

Autologous Breast Reconstruction

Surgical reconstruction of the breast contour utilizing the patient's own vascularized tissue flaps harvested from donor sites such as the abdomen (e.g., deep inferior epigastric perforator [DIEP] or transverse rectus abdominis myocutaneous [TRAM] flap), back (latissimus dorsi flap), or gluteal/thigh regions.

Alternate Names:
Autogenous Tissue Reconstruction

Autologous Fat Transplant

A procedure that removes fat from one area of a person's body and injects it into another area to restore volume or change shape. Some of the transferred fat may be reabsorbed, and repeat procedures may be needed.

Alternate Names:
Autologous Fat Grafting; Fat Transfer; Lipofilling

Autologous Stem Cell Transplantation

A clinical procedure in which a patient's own hematopoietic stem cells are mobilized, harvested from peripheral blood or bone marrow, cryopreserved, and reinfused following high-dose myeloablative chemotherapy or radiation to rescue bone marrow hematopoiesis.

Alternate Names:
Auto-SCT

Autolysis

The breakdown of cells or tissues by their own enzymes, usually after the cells die. This natural process contributes to tissue decomposition and can affect specimens examined after death.

Automated External Defibrillator

A portable device that checks the heart rhythm during cardiac arrest and gives an electrical shock when an abnormal rhythm may respond to one. It provides spoken or visual instructions for using it safely.

Automaticity

The physiological capacity of specialized cardiac pacemaker myocytes (principally in the sinoatrial node, atrioventricular junction, and His-Purkinje system) to undergo spontaneous diastolic phase 4 depolarization and generate action potentials without external neurohumoral stimulation.

Autonomic Disorder

A problem affecting nerves that control automatic body functions such as blood pressure, heart rate, digestion, sweating, bladder emptying, sexual function, and pupil size. Causes include diabetes, nerve disease, infection, immune disease, and medicines; symptoms depend on the affected functions.

Autonomic Dysreflexia

A sudden, potentially life-threatening rise in blood pressure in a person with a spinal-cord injury, usually at or above the upper chest. A problem such as a full bladder or bowel below the injury can trigger pounding headache, sweating, flushing, or heart-rate changes.

Autonomic Ganglion

A small group of nerve-cell bodies outside the brain and spinal cord that passes signals between the autonomic nervous system and organs such as the heart, intestines, glands, and bladder.

Autonomic Nervous System

The part of the nervous system that controls body functions that usually happen without conscious effort, including heart rate, blood pressure, digestion, sweating, pupil size, bladder activity, and sexual responses.

Autonomic Neuropathy

Damage to nerves that control automatic functions such as blood pressure, heart rate, digestion, sweating, bladder emptying, and sexual function. Diabetes is common, but other diseases, toxins, and medicines can also cause it.

Alternate Names:
Dysautonomia; Autonomic Nerve Dysfunction

Autophagy

A normal process in which cells break down and recycle worn-out proteins and cell parts. It helps cells survive stress and remove damaged material, but abnormal autophagy may contribute to some cancers and other diseases.

Autophobia

An abnormal, persistent fear of being alone, isolated, or without companion support, producing acute anxiety and panic symptoms when left by oneself.

Alternate Names:
Monophobia; Isolophobia; Fear of Being Alone

Autopsy

A medical examination of a body after death. It may include external examination, examination of internal organs, tissue testing, and sometimes toxicology to help determine the cause of death or study disease.

Alternate Names:
Post-Mortem Examination; Necropsy; Obduction

Autoradiography

A laboratory method that uses a radioactive label and a photographic or digital detector to show where a substance is located in a tissue, cell, or biological sample.

Autoregulation

The ability of an organ or vascular bed to maintain relatively stable blood flow despite changes in perfusion pressure.

Autosomal Dominant

Alternate name; see *Autosomal Dominant Inheritance*.

Autosomal Dominant Inheritance

Inheritance in which one altered copy of a gene on a non-sex chromosome can cause a condition. Each child of a parent with one altered copy commonly has a one-in-two chance of inheriting it.

Autosomal Dominant PKD

Alternate name; see *Autosomal Dominant Polycystic Kidney Disease*.

Autosomal Dominant Polycystic Kidney Disease

An autosomal dominant inherited disease, usually caused by a change in the *PKD1* or *PKD2* gene, in which many cysts gradually enlarge the kidneys and can reduce kidney function. It may cause high blood pressure, pain, blood in the urine, kidney infections, liver cysts, or rarely brain-artery aneurysms.

Alternate Names:
ADPKD

Autosomal Dominant Tubulointerstitial Kidney Disease

An inherited disease that gradually damages the kidney's small tubules and surrounding tissue. Kidney function declines, often without much protein or blood in the urine; some forms cause early gout, low blood pressure, or anaemia.

Autosomal Inheritance

The passing of a genetic trait through one of the 22 pairs of chromosomes that are not sex chromosomes. Such traits can affect people of any sex and may follow dominant or recessive patterns.

Autosomal Recessive

A pattern of inheritance in which a condition usually develops only when both copies of a gene are altered. Parents with one altered copy are often healthy carriers but can pass the condition to a child.

Autosomal Recessive Disorders

Conditions that usually occur when a person inherits an altered copy of the same gene from each parent. People with one altered copy are often healthy carriers.

Autosomal Recessive Inheritance

Inheritance in which a condition usually requires altered copies of a gene from both parents. When both parents are carriers, each pregnancy commonly has a one-in-four chance of producing an affected child.

Autosomal Recessive PKD

Alternate name; see *Autosomal Recessive Polycystic Kidney Disease*.

Autosomal Recessive Polycystic Kidney Disease

An inherited disease that usually affects babies or children, causing enlarged kidneys with small cysts and progressive kidney problems. It can also cause liver scarring, high blood pressure, and breathing problems in severe early disease.

Alternate Names:
ARPKD

Autosome

Any chromosome that is not a sex chromosome. Humans usually have 22 pairs of autosomes. Genes on these chromosomes can cause inherited conditions in people of any sex.

Alternate Names:
Non-Sex Chromosome

Avascular Necrosis

Cellular death of bone components caused by an interruption of the subchondral blood supply, leading to bone collapse and secondary osteoarthritis; see

Osteonecrosis.

Alternate Names:
AVN; Osteonecrosis; Aseptic Necrosis; Ischemic Bone Necrosis

Avascular Necrosis Of The Femoral Head

Death of bone tissue in the ball-shaped top of the thighbone because its blood supply is reduced or cut off. It may cause groin or hip pain and, over time, collapse of the bone and joint damage.

Alternate Names:
Osteonecrosis Of The Femoral Head; Avascular Necrosis Of The Hip

Avastin

Brand name; see *Bevacizumab*.

Avian Flu

Alternate name; see *Avian Influenza*.

Avian Influenza

An infection caused by avian-adapted influenza A virus strains (such as H5N1, H5N6, or H7N9) transmitted to humans primarily via direct contact with infected poultry or contaminated environments. Clinical manifestations range from conjunctivitis and upper respiratory symptoms to fulminant viral pneumonia, acute respiratory distress syndrome (ARDS), multi-organ failure, and death.

Alternate Names:
Bird Flu; Avian Flu

AVM

Abbreviation; see *Arteriovenous Malformation*.

AVN

Abbreviation for avascular necrosis; see *Osteonecrosis*.

Avoidance Behavior

Actions taken to stay away from a feared or distressing situation, thought, place, person, or activity. Avoidance may briefly reduce anxiety but can keep the fear going and interfere with treatment, work, relationships, or daily life.

Avoidant Personality Disorder

A long-term pattern of avoiding social contact because of strong feelings of inadequacy and fear of criticism, embarrassment, or rejection. It can limit relationships and work.

Avoidant/Restrictive Food Intake Disorder

An eating disorder characterized by persistent failure to meet appropriate nutritional or energy needs, resulting in significant weight loss, nutritional deficiency, dependence on enteral feeding/supplements, or marked interference with psychosocial functioning. Unlike anorexia nervosa, the restriction is driven by sensory sensitivity, lack of interest in eating, or fear of aversive consequences (e.g., choking or vomiting), rather than body-image disturbance.

Alternate Names:
ARFID; Selective Eating Disorder

Avoidant/Restrictive Food Intake Disorder (ARFID)

Alternate name; see *Avoidant/Restrictive Food Intake Disorder*.

Avolition

A marked reduction in motivation or ability to begin and complete purposeful activities. A person may neglect hygiene, household tasks, work, or social contact. It can occur in schizophrenia, severe depression, and other conditions.

Avulsed Tooth

A tooth completely displaced from its socket by injury. Avulsion may affect a primary or permanent tooth and can damage periodontal ligament cells and the surrounding socket. Tooth viability depends partly on the condition of these tissues after displacement. It is distinct from an intruded tooth, which remains displaced within the socket.

Avulsion

An injury in which tissue is partly or completely torn away by force. It may involve skin, muscle, a nail, a fingertip, or a tooth and can cause severe bleeding, tissue loss, infection, and loss of function.

Avulsion Fracture

A break in which a tendon or ligament pulls off a small piece of attached bone, usually during a sudden movement or injury. Treatment depends on the bone, fragment position, joint involvement, age, and associated damage.

Avuncular

In medical genetics, describing the relationship between a person and their biological aunt or uncle (a parent's sibling), or between that relative and their niece or nephew. Avuncular relationships may be shown on a family tree. A relative by marriage may be an aunt or uncle socially but is not biologically related through this connection.

Awake Craniotomy

A brain operation that opens the skull while the patient is awake for part of the procedure. The team tests functions such as speech or movement and may use electrical stimulation to map nearby areas that need protection. It is used mainly for tumors near these areas and sometimes for epilepsy surgery.

Alternate Names:
Awake Brain Surgery; Intraoperative Brain Mapping; Functional Craniotomy

Awake Fiberoptic Intubation

A method of placing a breathing tube while the person remains awake and breathes independently. Numbing medicine and a flexible camera are used to guide the tube when a difficult airway is expected.

Awareness

Conscious recognition of oneself, surroundings, thoughts, or sensations. Clinicians assess it along with alertness, attention, memory, and orientation when examining brain function.

Alternate Names:
Consciousness

Awareness Under Anesthesia

Unintended awareness or memory of events during general anaesthesia. A person may hear sounds, feel pressure or pain, or recall part of the operation; although uncommon, it can cause significant distress and needs support.

Axenfeld-Rieger Syndrome

A rare autosomal dominant developmental disorder affecting anterior eye structures and systemic tissues, characterized by anterior segment dysgenesis (such as iris hypoplasia, corectopia, and polycoria) with high risk of early-onset glaucoma, often accompanied by craniofacial and dental anomalies.

Alternate Names:
Axenfeld-Rieger Malformation

Axial Skeleton

The bones forming the central framework of the body: the skull, spine, ribs, breastbone, and associated small bones of the neck. It supports the body and protects the brain, spinal cord, heart, and lungs.

Axial Spondyloarthritis

Long-term inflammation affecting the joints between the spine and pelvis and other parts of the spine. It commonly causes back pain and stiffness that improve with movement and may eventually limit spinal flexibility.

Axilla

The hollow area beneath the shoulder, commonly called the armpit. It contains major blood vessels, nerves, lymph nodes, and tissues connecting the chest and neck with the arm.

Axillary

Relating to the armpit or to structures within it, including the axillary blood vessels, nerves, and lymph nodes.

Alternate Names:
Armpit-Related; Pertaining to the Axilla

Axillary Artery

The main artery passing through the armpit and supplying blood to the shoulder, chest wall, and arm. It continues as the brachial artery near the lower border of the armpit.

Axillary Dissection

Surgery that removes selected lymph nodes and nearby tissue from the armpit, often for cancer assessment or treatment. It may cause numbness, shoulder stiffness, fluid collection, nerve injury, or swelling of the arm.

Alternate Names:
Axillary Node Dissection

Axillary Lymphadenectomy

An operation to remove lymph nodes from the armpit, usually to assess or treat breast cancer or melanoma. Possible complications include pain, numbness, shoulder stiffness, a fluid collection, nerve injury, and arm swelling.

Axillary Lymphadenopathy

An abnormal enlargement, induration, or matted consistency of the lymph nodes within the axilla. It receives lymphatic drainage from the ipsilateral breast, upper extremity, and chest wall. Major causes include metastatic breast carcinoma, lymphomas, melanoma, acute pyogenic infections of the upper limb, cat-scratch disease (Bartonella henselae), tuberculosis, and systemic autoimmune diseases.

Alternate Names:
Axillary Adenopathy; Enlarged Axillary Nodes

Axillary Lymph Node

A lymph node in the armpit that drains lymph from the arm, chest wall, and parts of the breast. Its size or involvement by cancer, infection, or inflammation may be assessed by examination or imaging.

Axillary Nerve

A nerve from the neck that passes around the shoulder and supplies muscles that lift the arm. It also provides feeling over the outer shoulder and may be injured by shoulder dislocation or upper-arm fracture.

Axillary Nerve Dysfunction

Impairment of the axillary nerve, often from shoulder trauma, dislocation, compression, or surgery. It can cause weakness of shoulder abduction, deltoid wasting, and numbness over the lateral shoulder.

Axillary Tail Of The Breast

The extension of breast tissue toward the armpit.

Alternate Names:
Tail of Spence

Axillary Vein

A large vein in the armpit that drains blood from the arm and shoulder. It continues beneath the collarbone as the subclavian vein and returns blood toward the heart.

Axillo-Subclavian Vein Thrombosis

Deep vein thrombosis involving the axillary and subclavian veins of the upper extremity, commonly occurring in young, athletic individuals as a result of mechanical compression at the thoracic outlet during repetitive strenuous arm motions (Paget-Schroetter syndrome) or secondary to central venous catheters.

Alternate Names:
Effort Thrombosis; Paget-Schroetter Syndrome

Axis

The second bone in the neck. Its tooth-like projection acts as a pivot for the first neck bone, allowing the head and upper neck to rotate.

Axis Vertebra

The second neck vertebra, whose tooth-like projection allows the first vertebra and head to rotate while protecting the spinal cord.

Alternate Names:
C2; Axis

Axolemma

The thin outer membrane surrounding a nerve cell's axon. It maintains the electrical difference needed for nerve impulses and contains channels that allow those impulses to travel along the axon.

Axon

The long extension of a nerve cell that carries electrical signals away from the cell body toward another

nerve cell, muscle, or gland.

Axonal Transport

The movement of proteins, cell parts, and other materials along a nerve cell's axon between the cell body and the axon terminal. It supports nerve-cell maintenance and communication.

Axoneme

The internal framework of tiny tubes inside a cilium or sperm tail. Together with motor proteins, it produces the bending movements that help move fluid over cells or propel sperm.

Axon Fasciculation

The process during development in which growing nerve fibres group together to form organized nerve pathways. Chemical guidance signals and cell connections help them reach their correct targets.

Axon Guidance

The process by which growing nerve fibres find and connect with their correct targets during development. Chemical signals and surrounding cells help direct their path.

Axon Hillock

The cone-shaped part where a nerve cell's main body joins its axon, the long fiber that carries signals away. It combines incoming electrical signals and usually starts the nerve impulse when those signals are strong enough.

Axonotmesis

A moderate degree of peripheral nerve injury in Seddon's classification characterized by disruption of the internal axon and its myelin sheath with subsequent Wallerian degeneration distal to the lesion site, but with anatomical preservation of the surrounding endoneurium, perineurium, and epineurium, allowing spontaneous axonal regeneration.

Axon Terminal

The end of a nerve-cell axon where chemical messengers are released to communicate with another nerve cell, muscle, or gland.

Ayurveda

A traditional system of health care from India that uses ideas about bodily balance and may include diet, lifestyle practices, massage, and herbal products. Some products can interact with medicines or contain harmful contaminants.

Ayurvedic Medicine

Health care based on traditional Indian theories of bodily balance, using individualized diet, lifestyle practices, physical treatments, and herbal products. Evidence and safety vary, and some products may interact with medicines or contain toxic ingredients.

Azole Antifungals

A group of medicines that stop fungi making ergosterol, a substance needed for strong cell membranes. This weakens or kills the fungus. They can interact with other medicines and may affect the liver or heart rhythm.

Azoospermia

The absence of sperm in semen on laboratory examination. It may result from a blockage that prevents sperm from leaving the reproductive tract or from reduced or absent sperm production in the testes.

Azotaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Azotemia*.

Azotemia

A build-up of nitrogen-containing waste products in the blood, usually because the kidneys are filtering less effectively. It may occur with dehydration, reduced kidney blood flow, or kidney disease.

Azygos Vein

A large vein running along the right side of the spine that drains blood from the chest wall into the superior vena cava. It provides an alternate route for blood when major veins are blocked.

Azygous Vein

Alternate spelling; see *Azygos Vein*.

B

2,3-Bisphosphoglycerate

A molecule made in red blood cells that binds to deoxygenated hemoglobin and reduces its affinity for oxygen. This promotes oxygen release to tissues and helps the blood adapt to changes in oxygen availability.

Alternate Names:
2,3-BPG; 2,3-DPG

Ba

The chemical symbol for barium, a metallic element used in compounds such as barium sulfate. Barium sulfate can be swallowed or given as an enema to outline parts of the digestive tract on X-rays.

Babcock Clamp

A surgical instrument with smooth, rounded jaws used to hold delicate tubular tissue gently. It may be used on the intestine, fallopian tubes, or other tissues that could be injured by a crushing clamp.

Babesia

A group of parasites transmitted mainly by certain ticks. They infect red blood cells and can cause fever, tiredness, anaemia, low platelets, jaundice, or dark urine; severe illness is more likely without a spleen or with weak immunity.

Babesia Divergens

A species of parasite that infects red blood cells and can cause babesiosis, especially in Europe. It may cause severe destruction of red cells, particularly in people without a spleen or with a weakened immune system.

Babesia Microti

A parasite and the most common cause of babesiosis in North America. It is spread by black-legged ticks, infects red blood cells, and may cause no symptoms or severe anaemia, jaundice, and organ failure.

Babesiosis

An infection caused by Babesia parasites, usually spread by ticks. The parasites enter red blood cells and may cause fever, tiredness, anaemia, low platelets, jaundice, or dark urine; severe disease can affect several organs.

Babinski Reflex

A neurological test performed by gently stroking the sole of the foot. In healthy older children and adults, the toes curl downward. In a positive Babinski reflex, the big toe points upward and the other toes fan outward. This upward response is normal in infants under two years old because their nervous systems are still maturing, but in adults, it signals underlying damage to the brain or spinal cord nerve pathways.

Alternate Names:
Babinski Sign; Extensor Plantar Reflex; Babinski Response

Baby Acne

A common, imprecise name for acne-like bumps in a newborn. It may refer to neonatal acne, which can include blackheads or whiteheads (comedones), or neonatal cephalic pustulosis, a red papular or pustular rash on the face or scalp without comedones. The terms are sometimes used interchangeably, but describe different patterns; both usually

resolve without scarring.

Baby Blues

A common short period of tearfulness, irritability, anxiety, or mood changes beginning in the first days after childbirth. It usually improves within two weeks; persistent, severe, or dangerous thoughts may indicate postnatal depression or an emergency.

Bachmann Bundle Pacing

Atrial pacing delivered near Bachmann bundle, a major muscular conduction pathway between the right and left atria. It aims to shorten interatrial conduction delay and coordinate atrial activation; its clinical role is still being studied.

Bacillaceae

A family of rod-shaped bacteria that includes species able to form resistant spores. Some members are harmless or useful, while others can cause infections such as anthrax or food poisoning.

Bacillary Angiomatosis

A vascular infection caused mainly by *Bartonella henselae* or *Bartonella quintana*, usually in people with weakened immunity. It produces friable red-to-purple papules or nodules and may involve lymph nodes, liver, spleen, bone, or other organs. Tissue testing can distinguish it from Kaposi sarcoma.

Bacillary Dysentery

An intestinal infection causing fever, abdominal cramps, and diarrhoea that may contain blood or mucus. Shigella is a common cause; some invasive strains of Escherichia coli and other bacteria can produce a similar illness.

Bacille Calmette-Guérin

A live attenuated strain of *Mycobacterium bovis* used as a tuberculosis vaccine in many countries and as an intravesical immune treatment for selected non-muscle-invasive bladder cancers.

Bacille Calmette-Guérin Vaccine

A live attenuated *Mycobacterium bovis* vaccine used in many countries to reduce severe tuberculosis in children. Its use varies with local tuberculosis risk; it can also affect tuberculin skin-test results.

Alternate Names:
BCG Vaccine

Bacilluria

The presence of rod-shaped bacteria in urine, detected by microscopy or culture. It may represent contamination, harmless colonization, or a urinary infection; symptoms, the amount of bacteria, and the organism determine its significance.

Bacillus

A rod-shaped bacterium. The word can describe bacterial shape or members of the Bacillus genus, many of which form resistant spores; some are harmless, while others cause disease.

Bacillus Anthracis

A spore-forming bacterium that causes anthrax in people and animals. Infection may affect the skin, digestive tract, or lungs and can rapidly become life-threatening.

Bacillus Cereus

A spore-forming bacterium that can cause food poisoning after contaminated food is eaten. It may cause sudden vomiting or watery diarrhoea and, rarely, serious infections in people with weakened immunity.

Bacillus Cereus Food Poisoning

Foodborne illness caused by toxins of *Bacillus cereus*. The vomiting form usually begins within 1–6 hours and is linked to toxin already formed in food; the diarrheal form usually begins within 6–24 hours after toxin is produced in the intestine. Both are generally short-lived, and fever is uncommon.

Bacitracin

An antibiotic applied to the skin that prevents susceptible bacteria from building their protective cell wall. It is used for selected superficial infections, but it can cause skin irritation or allergic reactions.

Bacitracin Overdose

Toxic effects of excessive bacitracin exposure depend on the route and amount. Topical exposure most often causes local irritation or allergic contact dermatitis; systemic exposure to injectable bacitracin can cause severe kidney injury and hypersensitivity reactions. Injectable use is now uncommon because of these risks.

Bacitracin Zinc Overdose

Toxic effects of excessive exposure to topical bacitracin zinc depend on the amount and route. Local irritation or allergic contact dermatitis is more typical than systemic poisoning; kidney injury is associated mainly with systemic bacitracin exposure.

Backache

Pain or discomfort in the back, from the neck to the buttocks. It is a symptom rather than a disease and may result from muscles, joints, discs, nerves, or pain referred from an internal organ.

Back-Blows

A first-aid technique for severe choking in a responsive person, in which five firm blows are delivered between the shoulder blades to dislodge an airway blockage. Current American Heart Association guidance alternates five back blows with five abdominal thrusts for adults and children, and with five chest thrusts for infants.

Back Injury

Damage to the muscles, ligaments, joints, discs, bones, or nerves of the back after trauma, lifting, or repeated strain. Pain and stiffness are common; weakness, numbness, loss of bladder or bowel control, or severe pain after major trauma may indicate serious injury.

Back Labor

Severe back pain during labor, sometimes associated with the fetus being positioned occiput posterior. It may occur with or without typical abdominal contractions.

Back Pain

Pain or discomfort in any part of the back, from the neck to the lower back. It is often caused by muscles, joints, or discs, but may also arise from nerves or internal organs.

Alternate Names:
Dorsalgia; Backache; Spinal Pain

Back Spasms

Sudden or sustained involuntary tightening of back muscles, causing pain, stiffness, or restricted movement. They may follow strain, awkward movement, spinal or joint problems, or irritation of nearby nerves; weakness, numbness, fever, or loss of bladder or bowel control may indicate an underlying serious condition.

Back Strains and Sprains

Injuries involving overstretching or tearing of back muscles, tendons, or ligaments. They commonly cause localized pain, stiffness, and reduced movement after lifting, twisting, overuse, or trauma; neurologic symptoms may indicate a more serious injury.

Backwash Ileitis

Inflammation in the end of the small intestine that can occur with extensive ulcerative colitis. It often occurs alongside severe inflammation of the colon and may continue directly from the colon. It can resemble Crohn disease, so the rest of the bowel findings matter.

Baclofen

A medicine that reduces muscle spasm by lowering nerve signals in the spinal cord. It can cause sleepiness, weakness, dizziness, or confusion; stopping it suddenly after regular use can cause dangerous withdrawal symptoms.

Bacteraemia

Alternate spelling; see *Bacteremia*.

Bacteremia

The presence of viable bacteria in the bloodstream.

It may be transient, intermittent, or persistent and may cause no symptoms. Bacteremia is distinct from sepsis, which is life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated response to infection; either can occur without the other.

Bacteria

Microscopic single-celled organisms that lack a membrane-bound nucleus. Many are harmless or beneficial, while others cause infection; some form communities and can acquire antibiotic resistance.

Bacterial Adherence

The process by which bacteria attach to body cells or surfaces, often the first step in infection. Surface proteins and tiny hair-like structures help bacteria stay in place and resist removal.

Bacterial Arthritis

Infection of a joint by bacteria, causing pain, swelling, warmth, restricted movement, and often fever. It is a medical emergency because cartilage can be rapidly damaged and bloodstream infection may develop.

Bacterial Biofilm

A community of bacteria attached to a surface and enclosed in a protective material they produce. Biofilms can resist immune defenses and antibiotics and cause persistent infections on wounds, catheters, implants, or teeth.

Bacterial Capsule

A protective outer coating around some bacteria, often made of sugars. It can help bacteria avoid being swallowed by immune cells, survive in the body, and cause disease.

Bacterial Cell Wall

A strong outer layer that gives bacteria their shape and prevents them from bursting. Many bacterial cell walls contain peptidoglycan, a material made from linked sugars and short protein chains.

Bacterial Classification

The grouping of bacteria according to their genetic features, appearance, chemistry, and evolutionary relationships. Classification helps identify organisms, understand relatedness, and guide diagnosis, infection control, and treatment.

Bacterial Conjugation

The transfer of DNA from one bacterium to another through direct contact. The transferred DNA may include genes that help bacteria resist antibiotics or cause disease.

Bacterial Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the conjunctiva caused by bacteria. It can cause redness, irritation, and thick or pus-like discharge that may stick the eyelids together; it is often contagious. Eye pain, light sensitivity, or reduced vision may indicate corneal or other eye involvement.

Bacterial Dermatitis

Skin inflammation caused by bacterial infection. The skin may become red, warm, swollen, painful, or covered with pus or crusts. It can start in healthy skin or develop when bacteria infect an existing rash or wound.

Bacterial Dormancy

A low-activity state that allows bacteria to survive conditions in which they cannot grow. Some form highly resistant spores; others remain as ordinary cells that temporarily tolerate stress and may become active again when conditions improve.

Bacterial Endocarditis

Older term for infective endocarditis, an infection of the heart's inner lining, usually involving a valve. Most cases are caused by bacteria, but fungi can also be responsible; see *Infective Endocarditis*.

Bacterial Endocarditis Vegetations

Clumps of platelets, fibrin, microorganisms, and inflammatory material attached to a heart valve or other endocardial surface during infective endocarditis. They can damage valves or release emboli.

Bacterial Endospores

Highly resistant resting structures made by some bacteria, including Bacillus and Clostridium, when nutrients are scarce. They can survive drying, heat, chemicals, and long periods of time, then grow into active bacteria when conditions improve.

Bacterial Flagella

Thread-like structures that help some bacteria move through liquid or across surfaces. A rotating base works like a motor and turns the attached filament; flagella can also influence how bacteria attach and spread.

Bacterial Gastroenteritis

Acute inflammation of the stomach and intestines caused by pathogenic bacteria such as Salmonella, Campylobacter, Shigella, or pathogenic Escherichia coli. It commonly causes diarrhea, abdominal cramps, fever, and sometimes bloody stools or vomiting.

Bacterial Genetics

The study of bacterial genes, DNA, inheritance, and genetic change. Bacteria usually have one main chromosome and may carry extra DNA rings called plasmids that can include antibiotic-resistance genes.

Bacterial Growth Phases

The stages bacteria pass through when growing in a culture. They first adapt, then multiply rapidly, later reach a balance as nutrients fall and waste builds up, and finally decline as conditions become unsuitable.

Bacterial Infection

An illness caused by bacteria entering, multiplying, or spreading in body tissues. Many harmless bacteria normally live on the skin and in the gut, but disease-causing bacteria can invade the body or enter places that are usually free of germs, such as the bloodstream. They can damage tissue, make harmful substances, or trigger inflammation. Examples include strep throat, urinary infections, pneumonia, skin infections, and some food poisoning.

Alternate Names:
Bacterial Disease; Bacterial Illness; Bacteriosis

Bacterial Infections and Pregnancy

Bacterial infections during pregnancy can affect the urinary tract, vagina, cervix, placenta, or membranes and may affect the fetus or newborn. Their effects vary with the infection site, organism, and timing in pregnancy.

Bacterial Meningitis

A serious infection of the membranes around the brain and spinal cord. It can cause fever, severe headache, stiff neck, vomiting, confusion, seizures, or a rash and can progress rapidly.

Bacterial Meningococcal Meningitis

Meningitis caused by invasive *Neisseria meningitidis*. It may cause fever, severe headache, neck stiffness, confusion, vomiting, or a rapidly spreading purpuric rash and can progress rapidly.

Bacterial Metabolism

The chemical reactions bacteria use to obtain energy, build cell material, grow, and survive. Different bacteria use oxygen, fermentation, light, or other substances, and some of these processes are targets for antibiotics.

Bacterial Morphology

The size, shape, and arrangement of bacteria seen under a microscope. Common forms are spheres, rods, and spirals; bacteria may occur singly, in pairs, chains, clusters, or other patterns.

Bacterial Overgrowth

Small-intestinal bacterial overgrowth is an excessive number of bacteria in the small intestine, where relatively few normally live. It can cause bloating, abdominal pain, diarrhoea, weight loss, or vitamin deficiencies and may result from poor intestinal movement or structural changes.

Alternate Names:
Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth; SIBO

Bacterial Pathogenesis

The ways bacteria enter the body, attach to cells, invade tissues, avoid immune defenses, and cause illness. Damage may result from direct invasion, toxins, inflammation, or disruption of normal body functions.

Bacterial Peritonitis

A bacterial infection of the lining of the abdominal cavity. It may follow bowel perforation, surgery, another abdominal infection, or infection of abdominal fluid and can cause severe pain, fever, vomiting, and sepsis.

Bacterial Pharyngitis

Bacterial infection and inflammation of the throat, often caused by group A Streptococcus. It may cause sudden sore throat, fever, painful swallowing, swollen neck glands, and sometimes white patches on the tonsils.

Bacterial Pili

Tiny hair-like structures on the surface of some bacteria. They help bacteria attach to body cells or surfaces; some also help them move or take up DNA from their surroundings.

Bacterial Pneumonia

A bacterial infection of the lungs that causes inflammation and may fill air spaces with fluid or pus. It can cause fever, cough, phlegm, chest pain, shortness of breath, and low oxygen levels.

Bacterial Prostatitis

A bacterial infection of the prostate gland. It may cause pain in the pelvis or lower back, painful or frequent urination, fever, chills, or difficulty passing urine.

Alternate Names:
Infectious Prostatitis

Bacterial Protein

A protein produced by a bacterium that may form part of its structure, support its metabolism, help it attach to host cells, or contribute to disease.

Bacterial Spore

A dormant, highly resistant form made by some bacteria when conditions are harsh. Spores can survive drying, heat, and many disinfectants and may later grow into active bacteria when conditions improve.

Bacterial Toxemia

The presence or effects of harmful bacterial substances in the bloodstream. It can occur during severe infection and may cause widespread inflammation, low blood pressure, shock, or organ injury.

Bacterial Toxin

A harmful substance produced or released by bacteria that injures host tissues or disrupts normal cellular function. Bacterial toxins are classified into exotoxins (soluble proteins secreted by live Gram-positive and Gram-negative bacteria, such as tetanus, botulinum, and diphtheria toxins) and endotoxins (lipopolysaccharide components of the outer membrane of Gram-negative bacteria released upon cell lysis that trigger profound systemic inflammation and septic shock).

Bacterial Toxins

Plural form; see *Bacterial Toxin*.

Bacterial Tracheitis

A bacterial infection and swelling of the windpipe. It can cause fever, a harsh cough, noisy or difficult breathing, and rapid narrowing of the airway.

Bacterial Transduction

The transfer of DNA from one bacterium to another by a virus that infects bacteria. The transferred DNA may give the receiving bacterium new traits, including toxin production or antibiotic resistance.

Bacterial Transformation

The uptake of loose DNA from the environment by a bacterium able to absorb it. The new DNA may change the bacterium's features, including how it causes disease or responds to antibiotics.

Bacterial Vaginosis

A common vaginal condition caused by an imbalance in the natural bacteria normally present in the vagina. When beneficial bacteria decrease and other bacteria overgrow, it can cause a thin, watery, grayish-white vaginal discharge with a noticeable, often fishy odor, along with mild irritation or burning.

Alternate Names:
BV; Gardnerella Vaginitis

Bacterial Virulence Factors

Features that help bacteria cause disease, such as attaching to cells, entering tissues, avoiding immune defenses, producing toxins, or obtaining nutrients. Examples include surface proteins, protective coatings, enzymes, and toxins.

Bactericidal

Describes a substance or treatment that kills bacteria rather than only slowing their growth. Whether a medicine is bactericidal can depend on the drug, the bacterium, and the conditions.

Bactericide

A chemical or antimicrobial agent that kills bacteria under specified conditions. Its bactericidal activity depends on the agent, bacterial species, concentration, and test conditions.

Bacteriocin

An antimicrobial peptide or protein made by a bacterial strain that inhibits or kills other bacteria, often strains of the same or a related species. Bacteriocins differ in their structure and in which bacteria they affect.

Bacteriology

The study of bacteria, including their structure, genes, growth, spread, effects on health, and role in disease. It includes laboratory methods used to identify bacteria and test antibiotic sensitivity.

Bacteriophage

A virus that infects and replicates within bacteria, either through a lytic cycle (causing host cell lysis and death) or a lysogenic cycle (integrating its genome as a prophage into the host chromosome). Phages are investigated and utilized in phage therapy as targeted antimicrobial agents against multidrug-resistant bacterial infections.

Bacteriophage Lambda

A virus that infects the bacterium Escherichia coli. It may multiply and burst the bacterial cell or insert its genetic material into the cell's DNA and remain inactive until later.

Bacteriophages

Plural form; see *Bacteriophage*.

Bacteriophage T4

A virus that infects Escherichia coli, makes many copies inside the bacterium, and usually breaks the cell open to release them.

Bacteriorhodopsin

A light-sensitive protein in some microorganisms. It uses light energy to move charged particles across the cell membrane, helping the organism produce energy.

Bacteriostasis

The stopping or slowing of bacterial growth without necessarily killing the bacteria. The immune system can then remove the remaining organisms; this differs from an agent that directly kills bacteria.

Bacteriostatic

Describes a substance that stops or slows bacteria from multiplying without directly killing them. The body's immune system can then help clear the remaining bacteria.

Bacterium

A single bacterial cell. It usually lacks a nucleus, has genetic material in the cell interior, and may have an outer cell wall; some bacteria are helpful, while others cause infection.

Bacteriuria

The presence of bacteria in urine detected by testing. It may occur with urinary symptoms as part of an infection or without symptoms; significance depends on sample quality, bacterial quantity, pregnancy, and other clinical factors.

Bacteroidaceae

A family of bacteria that commonly live in the intestine and grow without oxygen. They are usually harmless in the gut but can cause abscesses or other infections if they enter wounds or body areas that should be free of bacteria.

Bacteroides

A group of bacteria that normally live in the intestine and grow without oxygen. They are usually harmless there but can cause abscesses or bloodstream infection if bowel contents enter wounds or other sterile areas.

Bacteroides Caccae

A bacterium that normally lives in the intestine without oxygen. It is usually harmless there but may be found in mixed abdominal or bloodstream infections when intestinal bacteria escape into other tissues.

Bacteroides Dorei

A bacterium that normally lives in the human intestine and grows without oxygen. It is generally considered a harmless member of the gut microbiota.

Bacteroides Fragilis

A bacterium that normally lives in the intestine without oxygen. If bowel contents leak into the abdomen, it is an important cause of abscesses, abdominal infection, bloodstream infection, and sepsis.

Bacteroides Gingivalis

An older name for Porphyromonas gingivalis, a bacterium that grows without oxygen in dental plaque. It is associated with inflammation and destruction of the tissues supporting the teeth.

Bacteroides Ovatus

An anaerobic Gram-negative bacterium that is part of the intestinal microbiota and can contribute to opportunistic infection if it enters damaged or normally sterile tissue.

Bacteroides Thetaiotaomicron

An anaerobic Gram-negative bacterium that is an important member of the human gut microbiota and helps break down complex dietary carbohydrates; it can cause opportunistic infection outside the intestine.

Bacteroides Ureolyticus

A bacterial name historically applied to an anaerobic, urease-producing organism now generally classified as Campylobacter ureolyticus, which can be associated with wound or bloodstream infection.

Bacteroides Vulgatus

An anaerobic Gram-negative bacterium commonly found in the human intestine that can contribute to infection when the intestinal barrier is disrupted.

Bad Breath

Alternate name; see *Halitosis*.

BAER

Abbreviation for brainstem auditory evoked response; see *Brainstem Auditory Evoked Potential*.

Bagassosis

An allergic lung inflammation caused by breathing dust from mouldy bagasse, the fibrous waste left after sugarcane juice is extracted. It may cause cough, fever, breathlessness, and fatigue after workplace exposure.

Bags Under Eyes

Mild puffiness or loose skin beneath the eyes. It commonly develops with aging, inherited facial features, lack of sleep, allergies, or fluid retention and is usually harmless.

Bag-Valve Mask

A hand-operated resuscitation device, also called a manual resuscitator, consisting of a self-inflating bag, one-way valves, a face mask or airway connector, and often an oxygen reservoir. It delivers positive-pressure ventilation and may be used with a face mask, supraglottic airway, or endotracheal tube.

Alternate Names:
BVM Manual Resuscitator Bag-Valve-Mask Device

Bag-Valve-Mask Ventilation

A method of giving breathing support with a hand-squeezed bag and face mask. It is used when a person is not breathing or is not breathing well enough. The rescuer keeps the airway open and gives gentle breaths using room air or added oxygen until normal breathing returns or more advanced airway support is provided.

Alternate Names:
BVM Ventilation; Bag-Mask Ventilation; Ambu Bag Ventilation; Manual Resuscitator Ventilation

Bainbridge Reflex

An increase in heart rate that can occur when extra blood stretches the upper chambers of the heart. It helps the heart move increased venous blood forward.

Baker Cyst

A fluid-filled bulge behind the knee that forms when excess joint fluid pushes into a small sac. It often occurs with arthritis, a meniscus injury, or another cause of knee swelling. It may cause tightness, pain, or stiffness, but small cysts may have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Popliteal Cyst; Baker's Cyst

Baker's Cyst

Alternate spelling; see *Baker Cyst*.

Baking Powder Overdose

Toxic effects after swallowing enough baking powder, a mixture that usually contains sodium bicarbonate and acid salts. It may cause vomiting and abdominal gas; large amounts can raise blood sodium and cause metabolic alkalosis, in which the blood becomes too alkaline.

Bak Protein

A protein on the outer membrane of mitochondria, the cell's energy-producing structures, that can help start controlled cell death. When activated, it makes openings that release cell-death signals; abnormal control may contribute to cancer.

Balamuthia

A genus of free-living amoebas found in soil and water. Some species can rarely infect people, usually causing slowly progressive inflammation of the brain and sometimes skin disease.

Balamuthia Mandrillaris

A free-living amoeba found in soil and water that can rarely infect humans. It may enter through broken skin or the nose and cause severe, gradually worsening infection of the brain or skin.

Balamuthia Mandrillaris Infection

A rare, often severe and sometimes fatal infection caused by the free-living amoeba Balamuthia mandrillaris. It may begin as a skin lesion and progress to granulomatous amoebic encephalitis with headache, confusion, seizures, or focal neurologic deficits. Diagnosis is difficult and uses specialized testing, including infectious-disease and neurologic evaluation.

Balance

The ability to keep the body steady while sitting, standing, or moving. It depends on information from the inner ear, eyes, muscles, joints, and brain; problems with any of these systems can increase the risk of falls.

Balance Assessment

An evaluation of steadiness during sitting, standing, walking, and changing position. It may include movement tests and review of vision, medicines, strength, sensation, and dizziness to identify fall risk and guide support.

Balance Disorders

Problems with steadiness or coordinated movement that may cause dizziness, unsteadiness, or falls. Causes include inner-ear disease, vision problems, brain or nerve disorders, muscle weakness, medicines, and blood-pressure changes.

Balance Disorders And Vertigo

Conditions that cause unsteadiness, dizziness, or a false feeling of movement. Causes may involve the inner ear, brain, nerves, vision, muscles, medicines, or blood pressure.

Balanced Study

A study design in which comparison groups are similar with respect to selected factors that could affect outcomes. Researchers may use matching, stratification, or restricted randomization to improve balance; random assignment alone does not guarantee equal baseline characteristics on every measured factor in the enrolled groups.

Balance Impairment

Reduced ability to remain steady while sitting, standing, or walking. It may cause swaying, stumbling, or falls and can result from inner-ear disease, vision problems, weakness, nerve disease, medicines, or brain disorders.

Balance Problems

Difficulty maintaining body stability while standing or moving, often caused by disorders of the inner ear, nervous system, vision, or muscles.

Balance Training

Exercises that practise posture, weight shifting, walking, and responses to movement to improve steadiness. They may be part of rehabilitation for balance problems or fall risk.

Balanitis

Inflammation of the glans penis. When the foreskin is also inflamed, the condition is called balanoposthitis. Causes include Candida or bacterial infection, irritants, trapped moisture, and skin disorders such as psoriasis or lichen sclerosus. Symptoms may include redness, swelling, itching, discharge, or soreness; recurrent episodes may be associated with diabetes.

Balanitis Xerotica Obliterans

An older name for genital lichen sclerosus affecting the foreskin or glans penis. It can cause pale, tight skin, itching, painful erections, difficulty passing urine, or narrowing of the urinary opening.

Alternate Names:
BXO; Penile Lichen Sclerosus

Balanoposthitis

Inflammation affecting both the glans penis and the foreskin (prepuce). It may cause redness, swelling, itching, soreness, discharge, or difficulty retracting the foreskin. Causes include infection, such as Candida or bacterial infection, irritant or allergic reactions, and inflammatory skin disease; diabetes and retained moisture can increase risk.

Balantidiasis

Intestinal infection caused by the ciliated protozoan *Balantioides coli* (formerly *Balantidium coli*). It may cause diarrhoea, abdominal pain, or colitis after ingestion of cysts in faecally contaminated food or water; infection may also be asymptomatic.

Balantidium

A genus of large, single-celled parasites that can infect the large intestine. Infection may cause diarrhoea, abdominal pain, or inflammation of the colon, although many infected people have no symptoms.

Balantidium Coli

Former scientific name for *Balantioides coli*; see *Balantioides Coli*.

Balantioides Coli

The current scientific name for the ciliated protozoan formerly called *Balantidium coli*. It infects the large intestine of humans and other mammals and is usually acquired by ingesting cysts in contaminated food or water.

Balbiani Body

A temporary cluster of cell parts and genetic messages near the nucleus of a developing egg cell. It helps organize materials that the early embryo needs after fertilization.

Baldness

Commonly used term for substantial hair loss, especially androgenetic alopecia, also called pattern hair loss. In this condition, genetically susceptible hair follicles gradually become smaller under the influence of androgens.

Alternate Names:
Pattern Hair Loss

Bald Tongue

Alternate name; see *Atrophic Glossitis*.

Balint's Syndrome

A rare disorder caused by damage to both back portions of the brain. It can cause difficulty seeing more than one object at a time, reaching accurately for objects while looking at them, and directing visual attention.

Ballance Sign

A historical examination finding of fixed dullness in the left flank with shifting dullness on the right, described in association with splenic rupture and intraperitoneal bleeding. It has limited diagnostic reliability and is now mainly of historical interest.

Ball-And-Socket Joint

A joint in which the rounded end of one bone fits into a cup-shaped part of another bone. It allows movement in many directions, as in the hip and shoulder.

Ballard Score

A newborn examination used to estimate how many weeks of pregnancy had passed at birth. It assesses physical features and muscle tone or movement; the estimate is useful when pregnancy dates or early ultrasound information are uncertain.

Ballism

A movement disorder causing sudden, involuntary, large, flinging movements of an arm or leg. It usually results from damage or dysfunction in deep movement-control areas of the brain.

Ballismus

Alternate name; see *Ballism*.

Balloon Aortic Valvuloplasty

A catheter procedure in which a balloon is inflated across a narrowed aortic valve to improve blood flow from the heart. The benefit may be temporary, and the valve can narrow again; some people later need valve replacement.

Balloon Brachytherapy

A form of internal radiation treatment in which a balloon catheter is placed in a body space, often the cavity left after breast-cancer surgery, and radioactive material is temporarily put inside it to treat nearby tissue.

Balloon Catheter

A thin flexible tube with an inflatable tip. It can widen a narrowed blood vessel or body passage, open a stent, stop bleeding by applying pressure, or help perform another procedure.

Balloon Dilation

A procedure that widens a narrowed blood vessel or body passage by inflating a small balloon at the narrowed area. The result and risks depend on the site and underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Balloon Dilatation; Balloon Angioplasty When Performed in a Blood Vessel

Balloon Occlusion

Temporary blockage of a blood vessel or other passage using an inflatable balloon on a catheter. It may control bleeding, test blood flow, or support another procedure; possible complications include reduced blood supply, clotting, and vessel injury.

Balloon Tamponade

Temporary control of bleeding or blockage by inflating a balloon inside or against a body passage or blood vessel. It applies pressure to the bleeding area but can injure tissue and requires close monitoring.

Balneology

The study of mineral waters, bathing, and spa treatments and their effects on the body.

Balneotherapy

Use of mineral or thermal water, baths, muds, or related spa methods as a therapeutic practice.

Balo Disease

A rare inflammatory demyelinating disease of the brain and spinal cord, also called Balo concentric sclerosis. MRI typically shows lesions made of alternating rings of damaged and relatively preserved myelin. It may cause progressive weakness, speech or thinking problems, seizures, or other neurologic deficits.

Alternate Names:
Balo Concentric Sclerosis

Balsam

A thick, resin-containing substance from certain plants, used in some fragrances, skin products, and traditional remedies. It can irritate the skin or cause allergic contact dermatitis in sensitive people.

Bamboo Spine

An X-ray appearance in advanced ankylosing spondylitis in which new bone bridges the spinal bones, making the spine look like a bamboo stalk. The spine may become stiff and more likely to break after injury.

Alternate Names:
Poker Spine

Band Cell

An immature neutrophil, a white blood cell that helps fight infection, whose nucleus has a curved band shape. Increased numbers may occur when the bone marrow responds to infection, inflammation, or severe stress.

Band Heterotopia

A rare birth-related brain-development condition in which a band of extra brain tissue forms below the brain's outer layer. It can cause seizures, learning problems, and developmental delay. Some cases are linked to changes in the *DCX* gene.

Alternate Names:
Double Cortex Syndrome; Subcortical Band Heterotopia

Band Keratopathy

A horizontal strip of calcium deposits in the clear front surface of the eye. It may result from long-term inflammation or high calcium levels and can cause irritation, blurred vision, or reduced sight.

B And T Cells

B cells make antibodies, while T cells coordinate immune responses or destroy infected and abnormal cells. Both are types of lymphocytes, a group of white blood cells that protect against infection and disease.

B And T Cell Screen

A blood test that measures B cells and T cells, two major groups of immune cells. It may help evaluate suspected immune deficiency, unusual blood-cell counts, or some blood cancers; results are considered with other tests.

B And T Lymphocytes

Alternate name; see *B And T Cells*.

BANF

Older abbreviation for bilateral acoustic neurofibromatosis, now called *NF2-Related Schwannomatosis*.

Bankart Lesion

A tear in the front-lower rim of the shoulder socket, usually after the upper arm has dislocated. It can make the shoulder unstable and increase the chance of repeated dislocation.

Bankart Repair

An open or arthroscopic surgical procedure performed to reattach and reconstruct a torn anterior-inferior glenoid labrum and stretched joint capsule (Bankart lesion) to the glenoid rim to restore joint stability following recurrent anterior shoulder dislocations.

Bannayan-Riley-Ruvalcaba Syndrome

A rare inherited condition that can cause many noncancerous growths, a large head size, intestinal polyps, extra freckles around the penis, and increased risk of certain cancers. It results from changes in the PTEN gene.

Banti Syndrome

A historical, imprecise name for splenomegaly and blood-cell abnormalities associated with portal hypertension. It covered several different disorders and does not identify a single modern diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Banti Disease; Banti's Syndrome

Barakat Syndrome

An inherited disorder that can cause low parathyroid hormone, hearing loss, and kidney abnormalities. These problems may occur together because of genetic changes affecting the development of several organs.

Barber Itch

An inflammatory infection of hair follicles in the beard area, often caused by bacteria or dermatophyte fungi and associated with itchy bumps or pustules.

Alternate Names:
Barber's Itch

Barber Say Syndrome

A rare congenital disorder caused by changes in the TWIST2 gene, characterized by excessive facial hair growth (hypertrichosis), loose, atrophic skin, a wide mouth, distinctive facial features, and eyelid abnormalities such as ectropion.

Barbiturate

A group of medications that slow down activity in the brain and central nervous system by enhancing the effects of calming brain chemicals. They produce effects ranging from mild relaxation and sleepiness to deep sedation and anesthesia. Because of risks of dependence and overdose, they are now mainly restricted to specialized medical uses such as controlling severe seizures or inducing general anesthesia.

Barbiturate Intoxication And Overdose

Poisoning caused by too much of a barbiturate medicine. It can cause extreme sleepiness, confusion, slow or stopped breathing, low blood pressure, coma, or death.

Barbiturates

Plural form; see *Barbiturate*.

Barbiturate Toxicity

Dose-related central nervous system depression caused by a barbiturate. Effects range from ataxia and slurred speech to coma, respiratory failure, low blood pressure, hypothermia, and loss of protective reflexes.

Bardet-Biedl Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder that may cause retinal degeneration, obesity, extra fingers or toes, kidney disease, and developmental or reproductive problems.

Alternate Names:
BBS

Bare-Metal Stent

An expandable metal mesh scaffold without an antiproliferative drug coating, deployed via endovascular catheterization to maintain vascular patency in coronary or peripheral arteries following balloon angioplasty.

Alternate Names:
BMS; Uncoated Vascular Stent; Bare Stent

Bariatric Embolization

A specialized catheter procedure that reduces blood flow to selected stomach arteries to alter hunger-related signaling and support weight loss. It remains limited or investigational in many settings and may cause bleeding, stomach injury, or other vascular complications.

Bariatrics

The medical field focused on preventing and treating obesity and related conditions. Care may include nutrition, physical activity, psychological support, medicines, and weight-loss surgery.

Bariatric Surgery

Operations that reduce stomach capacity or change digestion to support substantial weight loss and improve obesity-related disease. Potential long-term effects include nutrient deficiencies and other complications related to altered digestion or absorption.

Barium

A metallic element used medically mainly as barium sulfate, a substance that outlines the digestive tract during certain X-ray examinations. Soluble barium compounds are poisonous and are different from barium sulfate.

Barium-133

A radioactive form of barium used mainly to check and calibrate radiation detectors and imaging equipment. It is not ordinarily used as a diagnostic scan or treatment for patients.

Barium Enema

An X-ray examination of the large intestine after barium is introduced into the rectum. Air may also be added to show the bowel lining more clearly. It can show abnormalities such as narrowing, diverticula, or a mass.

Barium Meal

An X-ray examination in which swallowed barium coats the swallowing tube, stomach, and first part of the small intestine. It can show narrowing, ulcers, abnormal movement, or other structural changes.

Barium Study

An X-ray examination that uses barium to outline parts of the digestive tract. Examples include a barium swallow, barium enema, and upper-GI series. It can show the shape and movement of the digestive tract.

Barium Sulfate

A liquid or paste swallowed or placed in the rectum to outline the digestive tract during X-ray examinations. It is not absorbed normally, but breathing it into the lungs or leakage through a bowel hole can cause serious complications.

Barium Swallow

An X-ray examination of the swallowing tube after a person drinks barium. It can show narrowing, abnormal shape, or problems with movement. A barium follow-through continues the examination into the small intestine.

Barlow Maneuver

A clinical physical examination test used to detect developmental dysplasia of the hip in infants. The examiner adducts the flexed hip and applies gentle posterior pressure along the shaft of the femur; a palpable clunk or sensation of the femoral head slipping out of the acetabulum indicates hip instability.

Alternate Names:
Barlow Test; Barlow Dislocation Test

Barlow's Disease

Barlow's disease is an older name for severe vitamin-C deficiency, or scurvy, causing bleeding gums, bruising, poor wound healing, and bone or joint symptoms.

Barlow Sign

A positive Barlow maneuver in an infant: gentle posterior pressure on an adducted, flexed hip displaces an unstable femoral head out of the acetabulum. It indicates a dislocatable hip, not by itself the full diagnosis or severity of developmental dysplasia of the hip; see *Barlow Maneuver*.

Barlow Test

A physical examination maneuver for detecting hip instability in infants. With the hip flexed, gentle pressure is applied to see whether the femoral head can be displaced out of the socket, suggesting developmental dysplasia of the hip.

Barognosis

The ability to recognize and compare the weight of objects by holding them. Losing this ability despite normal basic touch sensation may indicate a problem in brain areas that interpret sensory information.

Baroreceptor

A sensory mechanoreceptor located primarily in the carotid sinus (innervated by the glossopharyngeal nerve, CN IX) and aortic arch (innervated by the vagus nerve, CN X). It detects changes in arterial wall stretch induced by arterial blood pressure, sending afferent impulses to the solitary tract nucleus in the medulla oblongata to reflexively regulate heart rate, myocardial contractility, and peripheral vascular resistance.

Baroreceptor Reflex

A rapid automatic response that helps keep blood pressure stable. Pressure sensors in major arteries signal the brain to change heart rate and blood-vessel tightness when blood pressure rises or falls.

Baroreceptors

Plural form; see *Baroreceptor*.

Baroreflex

A rapid reflex that helps regulate blood pressure by adjusting heart rate and blood-vessel tone in response to changes in arterial pressure.

Barotitis Media

Alternate name; see *Airplane Ear*.

Barotrauma

Injury caused by a sudden or large change in pressure, often affecting the ears, sinuses, or lungs. Ear barotrauma can cause pain, blocked hearing, or eardrum injury; severe lung barotrauma can cause a collapsed lung.

Barraquer-Simons Disease

A rare acquired disorder in which fat gradually disappears from the face, arms, and upper body while remaining or increasing around the hips and legs. It may be associated with immune disease and kidney complications.

Barr Body

The tightly packed, inactive copy of an X chromosome seen inside the nucleus of many cells that contain more than one X chromosome. It helps balance gene activity between cells with different numbers of X chromosomes.

Barrel Chest

A rounded, enlarged appearance of the chest caused by increased lung volume or changes in the chest wall. It may occur with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, severe asthma, or other long-standing lung conditions.

Barrett Esophagus

A condition in which the cells lining the lower esophagus (the swallowing tube) become damaged and change into cells similar to those found in the intestine. It is most often caused by long-term acid reflux repeatedly irritating the esophageal lining. While most people with Barrett esophagus never develop esophageal cancer, having this cell change increases the risk, so periodic monitoring is often recommended.

Barrett Esophagus Surveillance

Planned repeat examinations of the lower swallowing tube, usually with an endoscope and tissue samples, to look for precancerous cell changes or early cancer. Timing depends on whether abnormal cell changes are present and their severity.

Barrett's Esophagus

Alternate spelling; see *Barrett Esophagus*.

Barrett's Oesophagus

Alternate spelling; see *Barrett Esophagus*.

Barrier Creams

Skin products that form a protective layer against moisture, friction, irritants, and body fluids. They can help prevent or soothe irritation.

Barrier Nursing

Care practices used to stop infections from spreading between patients, staff, and visitors. They may include hand cleaning, protective clothing, masks, gloves, and keeping a person with a contagious infection separate when needed.

Alternate Names:
Isolation Nursing

Barthel Index

A scoring tool that measures how much help a person needs with daily activities such as eating, bathing, dressing, using the toilet, moving between surfaces, walking, and climbing stairs. It is used to track function and rehabilitation progress.

Bartholin Abscess

A painful collection of pus caused by infection of a Bartholin gland near the vaginal opening. It can cause severe swelling and pain when sitting or walking.

Alternate Names:
Infected Bartholin Cyst; Bartholin Gland Abscess

Bartholin Cyst

A benign, fluid-filled swelling caused by blockage of the duct of a Bartholin gland near the vaginal opening; see *Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess*.

Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess

A blockage of a Bartholin gland duct near the vaginal opening can form a usually painless, fluid-filled cyst; infection can cause a painful abscess. Rare gland tumours can resemble a cyst, particularly in older adults.

Alternate Names:
Bartholin Cyst; Bartholin Duct Cyst

Bartholin Gland

One of two small glands beside the vaginal opening that release lubricating fluid. A blocked duct can cause a cyst, and infection can cause a painful abscess with swelling and difficulty sitting or walking.

Bartholin Gland Cyst

See *Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess*.

Bartholin Gland Hyperplasia

Enlargement caused by an increase in the cells of a Bartholin gland. It may appear as a lump near the vaginal opening and can resemble a cyst or tumour.

Bartholin Gland Mucinous Cyst

See *Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess*.

Bartholinitis

Inflammation or infection of a Bartholin gland near the vaginal opening. It may cause pain, redness, swelling, or an abscess and can make sitting or walking uncomfortable.

Bartholin's Cyst

Alternate spelling; see *Bartholin Cyst Or Abscess*.

Bartholin's Glands

Alternate spelling; see *Bartholin Gland*.

Barth Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder of mitochondrial energy production caused by changes in the TAZ gene. It may cause heart-muscle disease, low muscle tone, weakness, poor growth, low neutrophil counts, and recurrent infections.

Bartonella

A group of bacteria usually spread by fleas, lice, ticks, or contact with animals. Different species can cause cat-scratch disease, trench fever, skin lesions, heart-valve infection, or bloodstream infection.

Bartonellaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Bartonella species. Members can cause cat-scratch disease, trench fever,

skin and blood-vessel lesions, bloodstream infection, or infection of the heart valves.

Bartonella Elizabethae

A species of Bartonella bacteria that has rarely been linked to bloodstream infection and inflammation of the heart valves, especially in people with underlying health problems.

Bartonella Henselae

The bacterium that most commonly causes cat-scratch disease. It is usually spread by a kitten scratch or bite and may cause a small skin bump, swollen nearby lymph nodes, fever, or, rarely, disease of other organs.

Bartonella Infections

Infections caused by Bartonella bacteria. They may produce swollen lymph nodes, fever, skin lesions, anaemia, heart-valve infection, or inflammation of organs; symptoms and severity depend on the species and immune status.

Bartonella Quintana

A Bartonella species spread mainly by body lice. It causes trench fever, with recurring fever, headache, bone pain, and weakness, and can sometimes cause bloodstream or heart-valve infection.

Bartonellosis

Infection caused by a Bartonella bacterium. Depending on the species, it may cause swollen lymph nodes, recurring fever, skin lesions, anaemia, heart-valve infection, or disease affecting several organs.

Bart's Hemoglobinopathy

A severe form of alpha-thalassemia caused by loss or inactivation of all four alpha-globin genes. Excess haemoglobin Bart's cannot deliver oxygen effectively, causing profound fetal anaemia and hydrops fetalis. It is usually fatal without fetal therapy, although survival after intrauterine transfusion has been reported.

Bartter Disease

Alternate name; see *Bartter Syndrome*.

Bartter Syndrome

An inherited kidney disorder causing excessive loss of salt and potassium in urine. It may lead to dehydration, low blood pressure, muscle cramps or weakness, frequent urination, excessive thirst, and poor growth in children.

Basal

Relating to the base of a structure or to a person's resting level of activity, such as resting metabolism or temperature measured after sleep.

Basal Body

A small structure at the base of a cilium or flagellum, such as a cell hair or sperm tail. It anchors the structure to the cell and helps organize the parts that produce movement.

Basal Cell

A cell in the deepest layer of an epithelial tissue, where it can divide and produce new cells. In the epidermis, basal cells help renew the skin and contain keratinocyte stem and progenitor cells.

Basal Cell Carcinoma

A common skin cancer arising from basal keratinocytes in the epidermis, often associated with ultraviolet exposure. It grows slowly and may appear as a pearly bump, a recurrent or nonhealing sore, or a scar-like patch. It can invade and damage nearby tissue, but spread to distant sites is rare.

Basal Cell Skin Cancer

Alternate name; see *Basal Cell Carcinoma*.

Basal Ganglia

Deep brain structures that help control movement, habits, learning, and emotions. Problems in these structures can cause tremor, stiffness, slowed movement, or unwanted movements.

Basal Ganglia Dysfunction

Abnormal function of deep brain structures that help control movement and learned habits. It may cause tremor, stiffness, slowed movement, twisting movements, or other involuntary movements, as in Parkinson disease or Huntington disease.

Basal Joint Arthritis

Alternate name; see *Thumb Arthritis*.

Basal Lamina

A thin layer beneath many lining cells that anchors them to supporting tissue. It also helps control movement of substances between the lining and the tissue below.

Basal Metabolic Rate

The amount of energy the body uses at complete rest to maintain essential functions such as breathing, circulation, temperature, and cell activity. It varies with body size, age, muscle mass, hormones, illness, and other factors.

Basal Nuclei

Groups of nerve cells deep within the brain that help start, stop, and control movement. They also contribute to learning, habits, motivation, and other thinking processes.

Basal Tear

A tear that is continuously present on the eye's surface. It keeps the cornea moist, smooth, and protected and helps wash away dust and microorganisms.

Basal Temperature

Body temperature measured immediately after waking and before eating, exercise, or other activity. A small sustained rise often occurs after ovulation and can help track menstrual cycles.

Base

A substance that can accept hydrogen ions or reduce acidity. In water, a base usually has a pH above 7; strong bases can burn tissue, while weaker bases are important in body fluids and chemical reactions.

Basedow's Disease

Older name; see *Graves Disease*.

Base Excision Repair

A way cells repair small areas of DNA damage. Enzymes remove the faulty DNA building block, fill the gap with the correct one, and seal the DNA strand.

Baseline

A starting measurement or description of a person's health before treatment, illness, or observation. Later findings are compared with it to identify improvement, worsening, or change.

Baseline EKG

An electrocardiogram recorded before treatment, a procedure, or a change in health. It provides a starting record for comparison with later heart tracings.

Alternate Names:
Baseline ECG; Reference Electrocardiogram

Basement Membrane

A thin supporting layer beneath many cells that line organs and body surfaces. It anchors the cells, helps control exchange with underlying tissue, and can act as a barrier to tumour spread.

Base Pair

Two matching building blocks joined inside DNA or RNA. In DNA, adenine pairs with thymine and cytosine pairs with guanine; in RNA, adenine usually pairs with uracil.

Base Pairing

The matching of complementary DNA or RNA building blocks. This matching helps copy genetic information accurately and allows RNA molecules to fold into useful shapes or attach to other molecules.

Base Sequence

The exact order of DNA or RNA building blocks in a

molecule. It carries genetic information and can be examined to identify inherited changes, mutations, or infectious organisms.

Basic First Aid

Immediate assistance for sudden illness or injury before definitive medical care. It aims to preserve life, prevent further harm, and support recovery until more advanced care is available.

Basic Life Support

Basic emergency care for cardiac arrest, respiratory arrest, and foreign-body airway obstruction. It includes recognition of emergencies, cardiopulmonary resuscitation, appropriate ventilation, and use of an automated external defibrillator. It also includes relief of airway obstruction before advanced care; exact tasks vary with age group and responder training.

Alternate Names:
BLS

Basic Metabolic Panel

A routine blood test measuring eight vital substances: blood sugar (glucose), calcium, four key electrolytes (sodium, potassium, chloride, and bicarbonate), and two waste products filtered by the kidneys (BUN and creatinine). It provides a rapid overview of fluid and electrolyte balance, kidney function, blood sugar control, and blood acid-base status.

Alternate Names:
BMP; Chem-7 (local name; composition varies); Chemistry Screen; Electrolyte and Kidney Panel

Basic Reproduction Number

The average number of people one infected person would infect in a population where everyone is susceptible, under specified conditions. It helps describe spread but changes with behavior, immunity, treatment, and the environment.

Basidiomycota

A major fungal group that reproduces by forming spores on club-shaped structures called basidia. It includes mushrooms, rusts, smuts, and some fungi that can cause human disease.

Basilar

Relating to the base or lowest part of a body structure. For example, a basilar finding may be near the bottom of the skull, lung, or another organ.

Basilar Artery

The artery formed by the union of the vertebral arteries that supplies the brainstem, cerebellum, and posterior brain.

Basilar Artery Aneurysm

A weak, widened area in the artery supplying the brainstem and back of the brain. It may press on nearby nerves, cause double vision or weakness, or rupture and produce life-threatening bleeding around the brain.

Basilar Artery Migraine

An older name for migraine with brainstem aura, a migraine subtype with reversible aura symptoms such as vertigo, double vision, slurred speech, unsteadiness, tinnitus, or reduced consciousness. At least two brainstem symptoms occur without motor weakness; the current term avoids implying that the basilar artery is the cause.

Alternate Names:
Migraine with Brainstem Aura; Basilar Migraine

Basilar Invagination

A condition in which the upper neck bones and the base of the skull are positioned abnormally, allowing the upper spine to press into the skull opening. It can compress the brainstem, spinal cord, or nearby nerves.

Alternate Names:
Basilar Impression

Basilar Membrane

A flexible membrane in the cochlea that supports the organ of Corti and vibrates in response to sound. Different parts respond best to different sound frequencies.

Basilar Skull Fracture

A fracture involving one or more bones at the skull base, including the temporal, occipital, sphenoid, ethmoid, or orbital plate of the frontal bone. Findings can include cerebrospinal fluid leakage, hemotympanum, Battle sign, or periorbital bruising, but may be absent.

Basilic Vein

A superficial vein that travels up the inner side of the forearm and arm and joins the brachial veins to form the axillary vein. It is commonly used for blood sampling, intravenous access, and placement of a peripherally inserted central catheter (PICC).

Basiliximab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks the interleukin-2 receptor alpha chain on activated T cells. It is used as induction immunosuppression, especially in kidney transplantation, and increases susceptibility to infection.

Basis Pontis

The basis pontis is the front portion of the pons containing descending motor fibers and pontine nuclei that relay signals to the cerebellum.

Basket Cell

A basket cell is an inhibitory interneuron that forms synaptic contacts around the cell body or axon initial segment of another neuron.

Basophil

A rare type of white blood cell involved in allergic and inflammatory reactions. It releases substances such as histamine and can increase in number with some allergies, infections, and blood disorders.

Basophil Adenoma

An older histologic term for an anterior pituitary tumour whose cells stain with basic dyes. It was often used for corticotroph tumours that produce adrenocorticotropic hormone, but staining alone does not establish hormone secretion. Current classification relies on cell lineage.

Basophilia

An unusually high number of basophils in the blood. It may occur with allergies, inflammation, infection, an underactive thyroid, or disorders in which the bone marrow makes too many blood cells.

Basophilic Focus

A localized group of cells in a tissue sample that stains more blue-purple than nearby cells because of altered cell contents or structure. It is a microscopic finding, not a diagnosis; for example, in liver tissue it can describe a cluster of hepatocytes with increased basophilic staining.

Basophilic Stippling

The abnormal presence of multiple fine or coarse, dark-blue granules scattered throughout erythrocytes on a Romanowsky-stained peripheral blood smear. The granules represent precipitated ribosomal ribonucleic acid (RNA) and are characteristically seen in lead poisoning, thalassemias, sideroblastic anemia, and myelodysplastic syndromes.

Alternate Names:
Punctate Basophilia

Basosquamous Carcinoma

A skin cancer with features of both basal-cell and squamous-cell carcinoma. It usually develops on sun-damaged skin and may behave more aggressively than ordinary basal-cell carcinoma.

Bassen-Kornzweig Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot make certain particles that carry fat in the blood. It causes poor absorption of dietary fat, deficiencies of fat-soluble vitamins, unusual red cells, and progressive nerve or eye problems.

Bateman Purpura

Alternate name; see *Actinic Purpura*.

Bather's Itch

Alternate name; see *Swimmer's Itch*.

Bathing An Infant

Washing an infant with water for hygiene. Bathing practices vary with age, skin condition, and cultural custom.

Bathing A Patient In Bed

Washing a person who cannot safely get out of bed, usually with the assistance of a caregiver or clinical staff. It supports hygiene and comfort during illness, disability, or recovery.

Bath Salts Abuse And Addiction

Harmful use of synthetic stimulant drugs sold as "bath salts." They can cause agitation, paranoia, hallucinations, seizures, dangerous overheating, heart problems, dependence, or death.

Batrachotoxin

A very powerful poison found in some frogs and birds. It keeps nerve and heart sodium channels open, causing abnormal nerve activity, dangerous heart rhythms, paralysis, and potentially death.

Batroxobin

An enzyme derived from snake venom that changes fibrinogen, a blood protein, into fibrin, the material that strengthens a blood clot. It has been studied or used in selected bleeding and clotting settings and can alter bleeding risk.

Batson Plexus

A valveless network of epidural and paravertebral veins that connects the deep pelvic and thoracic veins to the internal vertebral venous system. Because of the lack of valves and low intravascular pressures, it provides an alternate route for the retrograde hematogenous spread of pelvic infections and metastases (especially prostate and breast carcinoma) to the spine and central nervous system.

Alternate Names:
Batson's Venous Plexus; Vertebral Venous Plexus

Batson Venous Plexus

A valveless network of epidural and vertebral veins connecting the deep pelvic and thoracic veins to the internal vertebral venous plexuses and intracranial venous sinuses. Because it lacks valves, retrograde flow occurs during increases in intra-abdominal or intrathoracic pressure (such as coughing or straining), providing a direct pathway for the hematogenous dissemination of infections and metastases (notably prostate and breast carcinoma) to the vertebral column and brain.

Alternate Names:
Batson Plexus; Vertebral Venous Plexus

Batten Disease

A group of inherited neurodegenerative disorders, also called neuronal ceroid lipofuscinoses (NCLs), caused by lysosomal accumulation of ceroid lipofuscin in cells. Subtypes vary in age of onset and progression but commonly cause worsening seizures, vision loss, cognitive decline, movement problems, and loss of acquired abilities.

Battered Child Syndrome

Older term for physical abuse of a child; see *Child Physical Abuse*. Abusive head trauma is one possible form of child physical abuse, not a synonym for the broader term.

Battey Bacillus

An older name for the group of nontuberculous mycobacteria now called Mycobacterium avium complex. These organisms can cause lung disease, swollen lymph nodes, or widespread infection, especially when immunity is severely weakened.

Battle Sign

Bruising behind the ear over the bone, which is a warning sign of a break in the base of the skull.

Bauhin Valve

The valve between the last part of the small intestine and the first part of the large intestine. It helps regulate passage of intestinal contents and limits backward movement from the colon.

Bauxite-Workers' Lung

A lung disorder caused by long-term workplace inhalation of bauxite dust. It may produce scarring

or inflammation in the lungs and can cause cough, breathlessness, or reduced lung function.

Bax Protein

A protein that helps start programmed cell death when a cell is damaged or no longer needed. Excessive or insufficient Bax activity can affect cell survival and has been studied in cancer and other diseases.

Bayes Theorem

A rule for updating the likelihood of a diagnosis after new evidence. It combines the chance of the disease before the test with how accurately the test result supports or argues against that disease.

Bazin Disease

A chronic, nodular, and often ulcerating form of lobular panniculitis predominantly affecting the posterior lower legs of young or middle-aged women. It represents a delayed-type hypersensitivity reaction associated with Mycobacterium tuberculosis or other systemic antigens.

Alternate Names:
Erythema Induratum of Bazin; Erythema Induratum

Bazin's Disease

An older name for tender, inflamed lumps in the fatty tissue under the skin of the lower legs. It is sometimes linked with tuberculosis but can have other causes and may ulcerate as it heals.

B Cell

A type of white blood cell that develops in the bone marrow. After activation, it can become an antibody-producing cell or a memory cell that helps the immune system respond faster to a later infection.

Alternate Names:
B Lymphocyte; Bursa-Equivalent Lymphocyte

B-Cell Activation

The process in which a B cell receives signals after recognizing a foreign substance, then multiplies and develops into antibody-producing cells or long-lasting memory cells.

B-Cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia

A rapidly progressive cancer of immature B-lymphocyte precursors in the bone marrow. Abnormal cells crowd out normal blood-forming cells and may enter the blood, lymph nodes, central nervous system, or other organs.

Alternate Names:
B-Cell ALL; B-Cell Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia; Adult B-Cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia

B-Cell Acute Lymphoblastic Leukemia for Adults

Acute lymphoblastic leukemia arising from immature B-cell precursors in an adult. It can cause anemia, infection, bleeding, bone pain, and abnormal blood counts.

B-Cell Leukemia/Lymphoma Panel

A laboratory test that examines cells from blood, bone marrow, or tissue for abnormal groups of B cells. It uses cell features and marker proteins to help identify or classify some blood cancers.

B-Cell Lymphoma

A group of cancers that begin in B lymphocytes. Different types grow at different speeds and may affect lymph nodes or organs; diagnosis and treatment depend on the exact type, extent, and person's health.

B-Cell Receptor

A protein on the surface of a B cell that binds a particular foreign substance. This binding sends signals that can make the cell multiply, mature, and produce antibodies.

B-Cell-Targeted Therapy

Treatment that targets B cells, a type of white blood cell. Depending on the disease, it may reduce their activity or number, or direct immune cells to attack B-cell cancers. Examples include anti-CD20 antibodies and CAR T-cell therapy.

Alternate Names:
B-Cell Therapy

BCGosis

Infection caused by the live attenuated *Mycobacterium bovis* BCG strain after vaccination or intravesical bladder treatment. Infection may remain local or disseminate to organs, particularly in people with immune deficiency.

Beach Chair Position

A semi-sitting position used during some operations, especially shoulder surgery. Position-related risks include pressure injury, low blood pressure, and reduced brain blood flow.

Beacopp Regimen

A combination chemotherapy regimen used mainly to treat Hodgkin lymphoma; it includes bleomycin, etoposide, doxorubicin, cyclophosphamide, vincristine, procarbazine, and prednisone, with dosing and supportive care determined by the oncology team.

Beals Syndrome

A rare inherited connective-tissue disorder present from birth. It may cause permanently bent joints, long slender fingers and toes, a curved spine, and ears with a crumpled appearance; severity varies.

Beam Hardening Artifact

A false dark band or streak on a CT image caused when bone or metal removes some parts of the X-ray beam before it reaches the detector. It can obscure nearby body structures.

Beat Number

The number assigned to a particular heartbeat or rhythmic event when beats are counted or analysed. It can help describe timing, rate, or changes in a recorded heart rhythm.

Beau Lines

Transverse depressions or grooves across the nail plate caused by temporary interruption of nail-matrix growth. They may follow severe illness, fever, trauma, malnutrition, chemotherapy, or systemic inflammatory disease.

Beau's Lines

Transverse grooves or depressions across a fingernail or toenail caused by temporary interruption of nail-matrix growth. They may follow severe illness, injury, high fever, nutritional stress, or local trauma; the timing of the groove can help estimate when the event occurred.

Becaplermin

Becaplermin is a recombinant platelet-derived growth factor gel used in selected diabetic foot ulcers with appropriate wound care.

Bechterew Disease

An older name for ankylosing spondylitis, a long-term inflammatory disease affecting the joints between the spine and pelvis and often the spine itself. It causes back pain and stiffness that may improve with movement.

Alternate Names:
Ankylosing Spondylitis; Marie-Strümpell Disease

Becker Muscular Dystrophy

An X-linked recessive muscle disease caused by reduced or abnormal dystrophin, a protein that supports muscle fibres. It usually causes slowly progressive weakness beginning in childhood or adulthood and may also affect the heart.

Becker Myotonia

An inherited muscle condition causing stiffness because muscles relax slowly after contraction. It often begins in childhood, may improve after repeated movement, and can cause muscle enlargement, difficulty starting movement, or brief weakness.

Alternate Names:
Autosomal Recessive Myotonia Congenita; Recessive Generalized Myotonia

Becker Nevus

A usually harmless, irregularly shaped patch of

darker skin that often becomes noticeable during adolescence and may develop increased hair growth. It commonly affects one shoulder or the upper trunk and is not usually cancerous.

Becker's Muscular Dystrophy

Alternate name; see *Becker Muscular Dystrophy*.

Becker'S Nevus

Alternate name; see *Becker Nevus*.

Beck Triad

The classic triad of clinical signs associated with acute cardiac tamponade: hypotension, elevated jugular venous pressure with distended neck veins, and muffled or distant heart sounds.

Beckwith-Wiedemann Spectrum

A multigenic congenital overgrowth and tumor-predisposition genomic imprinting disorder caused by epigenetic or genetic alterations on chromosome 11p15.5. Hallmarks include macrosomia, macroglossia, lateralized overgrowth (hemihypertrophy), abdominal wall defects (omphalocele, umbilical hernia), neonatal hypoglycemia from hyperinsulinism, and organomegaly (visceromegaly). Patients carry an elevated risk of childhood embryonal neoplasms, predominantly Wilms tumor and hepatoblastoma, necessitating serial abdominal ultrasound and alpha-fetoprotein screening in infancy.

Alternate Names:
BWS; Beckwith-Wiedemann Syndrome

Beckwith-Wiedemann Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Beckwith-Wiedemann Spectrum*.

Beclomethasone

Beclomethasone is a corticosteroid used by inhalation, nasal spray, or topical routes to reduce inflammation in asthma, rhinitis, or skin disease.

Becquerel

The standard scientific unit used to measure radioactivity. One becquerel represents one atomic nucleus decaying or breaking down per second. In medicine, it is used to quantify the amount of radioactive material administered during diagnostic scans or radiation treatments.

Alternate Names:
Bq; SI Unit of Radioactivity

Bed Bug

A small, wingless, blood-feeding insect of the genus *Cimex* that hides in bedding, furniture, and cracks and feeds on humans and other animals, often at night. Bites may cause itchy bumps or allergic reactions, although some people show no skin reaction. Bed bugs are not known to spread human disease.

Alternate Names:
Bedbug; Bed Bugs

Bedbug Bites

Itchy skin reactions caused by bedbugs feeding at night. Bites may appear as red, swollen, itchy marks in clusters or lines on exposed skin, sometimes days after exposure; some people have no visible reaction. Bedbugs are not known to spread disease, but scratching can cause secondary infection and allergic reactions are possible.

Bedbugs

Alternate plural; see *Bed Bug*.

Bednar Aphthae

Shallow sores on the back of a baby's palate caused by pressure or rubbing, often during feeding. They may make feeding painful and usually improve when the source of irritation is corrected.

Bedpan

A container for collecting urine or stool from a person confined to bed or unable to use a toilet.

Bed Rest

Staying in bed or remaining mostly reclined to limit activity. Prolonged inactivity can cause muscle loss, blood clots, constipation, pressure injuries, and reduced independence.

Bedsore

A pressure injury, also called a pressure sore or pressure ulcer, caused by prolonged pressure or pressure combined with shear and friction. It usually develops over a bony area such as the heel, hip, elbow, or tailbone; limited movement, moisture, poor nutrition, and reduced sensation increase risk.

Alternate Names:
Pressure Ulcers; Decubitus Ulcers; Pressure Sores; Decubiti

Bedwetting

Alternate name; see *Enuresis*.

Bee And Wasp Sting

A sting from a bee or wasp that injects venom and usually causes immediate pain, redness, swelling, and itching. Trouble breathing, throat swelling, widespread hives, faintness, or vomiting may indicate anaphylaxis.

Beef or Pork Tapeworm Infection

Intestinal infection with Taenia saginata or Taenia solium acquired from undercooked beef or pork; T. solium eggs can also cause cysticercosis in tissues.

Beer-Drinker's Heart

Historical and informal term; see *Alcoholic Cardiomyopathy*.

Beers Criteria

A set of American Geriatrics Society criteria identifying potentially inappropriate medicines and medication situations for adults aged 65 and older. It includes drug-disease and drug-drug interactions and dose considerations for reduced kidney function; it supports, but does not replace, individualized clinical judgment.

Bee Sting

A venom-injecting injury from a bee that usually causes local pain, redness, and swelling. A severe allergic reaction can cause widespread hives, breathing difficulty, faintness, or swelling of the mouth and throat.

Alternate Names:
Apis Envenomation; Honeybee Sting

Bee Stings

Plural form; see *Bee Sting*.

Beeswax Poisoning

Illness after ingesting or inhaling a large amount of beeswax. Beeswax is generally of low toxicity, but large ingestions may cause gastrointestinal blockage or aspiration, especially in children.

Behavior

The observable actions, responses, and activities of an organism, influenced by genetic, neurobiological, psychological, and environmental factors. In medicine, behavioral assessment helps diagnose psychiatric, developmental, and neurological conditions.

Behavioral Abnormality

A deviation from typical patterns of behavior that may indicate a psychiatric, neurodevelopmental, or neurologic condition. It is assessed by history, observation, standardized measures, and developmental norms to determine clinical significance.

Behavioral Addiction

A compulsive pattern of engaging in a non-substance-related activity (such as gambling, gaming, or compulsive buying) despite significant adverse psychological, social, or occupational consequences; see *Gambling Disorder*.

Behavioral Disorder

A persistent pattern of behavior that causes clinically significant distress or impairment in daily functioning, relationships, learning, or safety. The term is broad; interpretation considers age, development, mental health, medical conditions, environment, trauma, and substance exposure.

Behavioral Genetics

The study of how genes and environmental factors influence behavior and mental traits. Most behaviors

reflect many genes interacting with life experiences, not one gene alone.

Behavioral Health Integration

A team-based approach that connects medical care with mental health and substance-use services through collaborative workflows, shared care planning, and coordinated follow-up. It addresses behavioral health conditions, health behaviors, and psychosocial factors that affect physical health. Integration may occur in primary care or specialty settings and does not require clinicians to work in the same office.

Alternate Names:
Integrated Behavioral Health Care

Behavioral Neurology

A neurology subspecialty focused on cognitive and behavioral changes caused by disorders of the brain. It assesses memory, language, attention, perception, and social behavior, often in conditions such as dementia, brain injury, or epilepsy, and may overlap with neuropsychiatry and other cognitive-disorder specialties.

Behavioral Rehabilitation

Structured therapy that helps a person change behaviors, build coping skills, and regain daily function after illness, injury, addiction, or disability. It may include counseling, goal setting, and practice of useful routines.

Behavior Disorder

A persistent pattern of actions or emotional responses that causes significant distress, interferes with daily life, or harms relationships. Causes may be developmental, psychological, medical, or environmental.

Behavior Test

A structured assessment of behavior, mood, attention, thinking, or social functioning. It may use observation, interviews, questionnaires, or standardized tasks to help identify developmental, psychiatric, or neurologic concerns.

Behavior Therapy

A form of psychotherapy based on learning principles that uses reinforcement, extinction, and other behavioral techniques to modify maladaptive behaviors. It is effective for anxiety disorders, phobias, obsessive-compulsive disorder, and habit disorders.

Behcet Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Behçet Disease*.

Behçet Disease

A long-term inflammatory disease that can cause repeated mouth and genital sores, eye inflammation, and skin problems. It may also affect the joints, blood vessels, nervous system, or digestive tract. Severe eye or organ involvement can threaten vision or organ function.

Alternate Names:
Behçet Syndrome; Silk Road Disease; Adamantiades-Behçet Syndrome

Behcet's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Behçet Disease*.

Behçet's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Behçet Disease*.

Behcet Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Behçet Disease*.

Behr Syndrome

A rare inherited neurological disorder causing progressive optic-nerve damage, poor vision, muscle stiffness, unsteady movement, and sometimes weakness or bladder problems.

Bejel

An endemic treponemal infection, also called endemic syphilis, caused by *Treponema pallidum* subsp. *endemicum*. It is spread mainly through close contact in affected communities and most often begins in childhood; skin, mouth, bone, and other tissues may be affected.

Alternate Names:
Endemic Syphilis

Bekam

A Malay name for cupping, a practice in which cups create suction on the skin; wet cupping may also involve superficial skin incisions.

Belching

The release of swallowed air or gas from the stomach through the mouth. Frequent belching may occur with aerophagia, gastroesophageal reflux, functional dyspepsia, or carbonated-drink consumption.

Belinostat

A cancer medicine that blocks enzymes involved in turning genes on and off. It is used for some peripheral T-cell lymphomas that have returned or resisted earlier treatment.

Belladonna

Atropa belladonna, the deadly nightshade plant, whose tropane alkaloids such as atropine and scopolamine can cause anticholinergic poisoning.

Bell-Clapper Deformity

A birth-related difference in how a testicle is attached inside the scrotum, allowing it to move and twist more freely than usual. It is often present on both sides and increases the risk of testicular torsion, a sudden emergency that cuts off blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Bell-Clapper Anomaly; High Tunica Vaginalis Insertion

Bell Palsy

A sudden, temporary weakness or paralysis of the muscles on one side of the face, caused by swelling or inflammation of the facial nerve (the seventh cranial nerve). Symptoms develop rapidly and include facial drooping, difficulty closing the eye, drooling, and altered taste. Unlike a stroke—which usually spares forehead movement—Bell palsy affects the entire side of the face, including the forehead and eyebrow.

Alternate Names:
Bell's Palsy; Idiopathic Facial Palsy

Bell's Palsy

Alternate spelling; see *Bell Palsy*.

Bell's Phenomenon

Upward and outward movement of the eyes when a person closes the eyelids forcefully. This normal protective reflex helps shield the cornea and may become visible when facial-nerve weakness prevents complete eyelid closure.

Belly

The abdomen, the region of the body between the chest and pelvis containing much of the digestive, urinary, and reproductive organs.

Below-Knee Amputation

Surgery to remove the lower leg while preserving the knee joint. It may be needed for severe injury, infection, poor blood flow, or cancer; rehabilitation focuses on healing, strength, mobility, and a prosthesis when suitable.

Bence Jones Protein

Free monoclonal immunoglobulin light chains (either kappa [κ] or lambda [λ]) produced by neoplastic plasma cells in disorders such as multiple myeloma, Waldenström macroglobulinemia, and primary amyloidosis. Readily filtered by the renal glomeruli, they can be detected by urine protein electrophoresis and immunofixation. They exhibit unique thermal solubility properties: precipitating upon heating to 40–60°C and redissolving upon boiling (100°C). In the kidneys, filtered light chains can precipitate with Tamm-Horsfall mucoprotein in distal tubules, causing obstructing casts and myeloma kidney (cast nephropathy).

Alternate Names:
Monoclonal Free Light Chains; Bence-Jones Protein

Bence-Jones Protein

Alternate spelling; see *Bence Jones Protein*.

Benchmarking

Comparing healthcare results, safety, costs, or processes with a standard or similar service. The com-

parison can identify areas for improvement but does not by itself prove that one service causes better outcomes.

Bendamustine

A cancer medicine that damages tumour-cell DNA and is used for selected blood cancers. It can also damage healthy bone-marrow cells, causing low blood counts, infection, tiredness, nausea, or other side effects.

Bendamustine Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride form of bendamustine, a chemotherapy medicine used for selected blood cancers. It damages DNA and may cause low blood counts, infection, infusion reactions, nausea, tiredness, or other side effects.

Bendiocarb

A carbamate insecticide that can overstimulate nerves after significant exposure. Poisoning may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhoea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, or weakness.

Bendopnea

Shortness of breath that occurs when a person bends forward. It has been described in some people with heart failure, often advanced disease, but is not specific to heart failure and may have other causes.

Alternate Names:
Forward-Bending Dyspnea

Bendroflumethiazide

A diuretic medicine that helps the kidneys remove salt and water. It is used for high blood pressure or fluid retention and may lower potassium or sodium and increase uric acid or blood sugar.

Bends

A form of decompression sickness caused by gas bubbles forming in the body when pressure falls too quickly, usually during or after diving. It commonly causes deep joint or muscle pain but can also injure the brain, spinal cord, lungs, or circulation.

Benedikt's Syndrome

A rare pattern of neurological problems caused by damage in the midbrain. It may cause a drooping eyelid or double vision on one side and tremor, poor coordination, or involuntary movements on the opposite side.

Benedikt Syndrome

A brainstem vascular stroke syndrome resulting from a paramedian lesion of the midbrain tegmentum involving the oculomotor nerve fascicles, red nucleus, and substantia nigra. It is clinically characterized by ipsilateral third cranial nerve palsy (ptosis, dilated pupil, downward-and-outward eye) and contralateral involuntary choreoathetosis, intention tremor, and ataxia.

Alternate Names:
Paramedian Midbrain Syndrome

Beneficence And Non-Maleficence

Two principles of medical ethics: beneficence means acting to benefit the patient, while non-maleficence means avoiding unnecessary harm. Good decisions balance expected benefits, risks, patient values, and available alternatives.

Benfotiamine

A fat-soluble derivative of thiamine (vitamin B1) sold as a supplement and studied for diabetic neuropathy. Evidence that it improves nerve symptoms remains limited.

Benfuracarb

A carbamate insecticide that can overstimulate nerves after significant exposure. It may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhoea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, or weakness.

Benign

Not cancerous. A benign growth does not invade nearby tissues or spread to other parts of the body, but it can still cause problems because of its size, location, or hormone production.

Alternate Names:
Nonmalignant; Noncancerous

Benign Adrenal Tumors

Noncancerous growths in an adrenal gland. Some are found by chance and cause no problems, while others release excess hormones or become large enough to cause pressure symptoms.

Benign Ameloblastoma

A usually slow-growing tumour arising from cells involved in tooth development, most often in the jaw. It is not cancer but can expand, damage bone, and displace teeth; recurrence is possible after removal.

Benign Brain Tumor

A noncancerous growth in or around the brain. Although it does not spread like cancer, it can cause headache, seizures, vision or movement problems, or fluid blockage by pressing on nearby structures.

Benign Chondroblastoma

A noncancerous cartilage-producing bone tumour that usually develops near the end of a long bone in an adolescent or young adult. It often causes pain, swelling, or reduced movement near a joint.

Benign CNS Cyst

A noncancerous, fluid-filled sac in or around the brain or spinal cord. Many cause no symptoms, but a large or strategically located cyst can press on nerves or block the normal flow of brain fluid.

Benign Ear Cyst Or Tumor

A noncancerous cyst or growth in or around the ear. Examples include an epidermal cyst or bony growth in the ear canal and a benign growth arising from a nerve near the inner ear. A lesion in the ear canal may obstruct it and reduce hearing; a growth near the inner ear may affect hearing or balance.

Benign Epithelioma

A noncancerous growth arising from epithelial cells, which line the skin and internal organs. Unlike a malignant epithelial tumour, it does not invade nearby tissue or spread to distant sites.

Benign Esophageal Stricture

A noncancerous narrowing of the esophageal lumen, most commonly resulting from chronic acid reflux injury (peptic stricture), corrosive ingestion, radiation, or prior surgery, causing progressive dysphagia.

Alternate Names:
Peptic Stricture; Esophageal Stenosis, Benign; Esophageal Stricture

Benign Fasciculation Syndrome

A neurological condition characterized by persistent, involuntary muscle twitching (fasciculations) in the absence of motor weakness, muscle denervation, sensory neuropathy, or an underlying motor neuron disease such as amyotrophic lateral sclerosis.

Benign Hemangiopericytoma

Older term; see *Solitary Fibrous Tumor*.

Benign Lesions of the Ovaries

Noncancerous ovarian growths or cysts, including functional cysts, endometriomas, dermoids, fibromas, and cystadenomas. Evaluation uses symptoms, examination, pregnancy testing, ultrasound, and sometimes tumor markers or surgery to distinguish benign disease from malignancy.

Benign Liver Tumors

Noncancerous liver growths, including hemangiomas, focal nodular hyperplasia, and hepatocellular adenomas. Many are found incidentally, but significance varies by type: adenomas can bleed and some subtypes can become cancerous, while other lesions rarely cause complications.

Benign Melanocytic Lesion

An older or imprecise term for a benign melanocytic growth, such as a melanocytic nevus or mole; unlike malignant melanoma, it is not cancerous.

Benign Melanocytic Nevi Pathology

Well-circumscribed proliferations of benign melanocytes arranged in nests or cords at the dermoepidermal junction and/or dermis. Typical lesions show maturation with depth and lack

significant cytologic atypia or destructive growth.

Benign Meningioma

A usually slow-growing, noncancerous tumour arising from the membranes around the brain or spinal cord. It may cause seizures, headache, weakness, or vision problems by pressing on nearby structures.

Benign Mesenchymoma

A rare noncancerous tumour containing more than one type of tissue such as fat, cartilage, or bone. Its symptoms depend on the site and size, and diagnosis requires examination of tissue.

Benign Migratory Glossitis

Alternate name; see *Geographic Tongue*.

Benign Mixed Tumor

Alternate name; see *Pleomorphic Adenoma*.

Benign Mullerian Papilloma

A rare noncancerous, wart-like growth in the vulva or vagina formed from Müllerian-type lining cells. It often appears as a small polyp and is diagnosed by examining a tissue sample.

Benign Myoepithelioma

A noncancerous tumour of myoepithelial cells, often arising in a salivary gland or other glandular tissue. It usually grows slowly and may cause a painless lump; diagnosis depends on tissue examination.

Benign Neoplasm

A noncancerous growth of cells that remains at its original site and does not spread to distant organs. It may still cause harm by pressing on nearby structures, blocking a passage, bleeding, or producing hormones.

Benign Orgasmic Headache

A sudden severe headache during sexual activity or orgasm for which bleeding, stroke, vessel disease, and other secondary causes have been excluded.

Alternate Names:
Primary Headache Associated with Sexual Activity; Sexual-Activity Headache

Benign Paraganglioma

An outdated, potentially misleading term for a paraganglioma without detected metastases. Paragangliomas arise from paraganglionic neuroendocrine cells and may release catecholamines; no histologic feature reliably excludes metastatic potential, so current descriptions specify tumour site and whether metastases are present.

Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo

A common inner-ear problem in which tiny calcium particles move into the wrong part of the balance system. Turning the head or rolling over can trigger brief spells of spinning dizziness, sometimes with nausea. Hearing is usually not affected.

Benign Peripheral Nerve Tumor

A noncancerous tumour arising from or beside a nerve outside the brain and spinal cord. It may cause a lump, pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or no symptoms at all.

Benign Positional Vertigo

Alternate name; see *Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo*.

Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia

A nonmalignant proliferation of stromal and glandular epithelial cells within the transition zone of the prostate gland, driven by androgenic stimulation (dihydrotestosterone via 5α-reductase). It is the predominant cause of bladder outlet obstruction in aging men, presenting with lower urinary tract symptoms (LUTS) comprising voiding difficulties (hesitancy, weak stream, intermittency, straining) and storage symptoms (urgency, frequency, nocturia). Medical management includes α_1-adrenergic antagonists (e.g., tamsulosin) and 5α-reductase inhibitors (e.g., finasteride).

Alternate Names:
BPH; Benign Prostatic Hypertrophy

Benign Prostatic Obstruction

Blockage at the bladder outlet caused by an enlarged

prostate or increased muscle tone in the prostate. It may cause a weak or interrupted stream, straining, incomplete emptying, urinary retention, or recurrent infection.

Benign Rolandic Epilepsy

A childhood seizure disorder, now often called self-limited epilepsy with centrotemporal spikes. Brief seizures commonly affect the face or mouth during sleep and may cause twitching, tingling, drooling, or temporary trouble speaking; it usually ends by adolescence.

Alternate Names:
Self-Limited Epilepsy with Centrotemporal Spikes; SeLECTS; Benign Childhood Epilepsy with Centrotemporal Spikes; Rolandic Epilepsy

Benign Skin Lesions

Noncancerous growths or localized changes in the skin, including skin tags, epidermoid cysts, dermatofibromas, and seborrheic keratoses. Some benign lesions can look like skin cancer, despite being noncancerous.

Alternate Names:
Benign Cutaneous Lesions; Noncancerous Skin Lesions

Benign Tumor

Alternate name; see *Benign Neoplasm*.

Benign Urethral Lesions

Noncancerous growths or structural changes in the urethra, such as polyps, caruncles, papillomas, or inflammatory lesions. They may cause bleeding, discharge, pain, narrowing, or difficulty passing urine, but some cause no symptoms.

Benign Vulvar Lesions

Noncancerous growths or skin disorders of the vulva, including cysts, warts, inflammatory lesions, fibromas, and pigmentary lesions. Some atypical lesions require tissue examination to distinguish them from vulvar neoplasia.

Bennett Fracture

An intra-articular fracture-subluxation of the base of the first metacarpal bone. The smaller medial articular fragment remains attached to the trapezium by the anterior oblique ligament, while the main metacarpal shaft is displaced proximally, laterally, and dorsally by the pulling force of the abductor pollicis longus tendon.

Benserazide

A medicine combined with levodopa in some Parkinson treatments. It blocks levodopa from being changed into dopamine outside the brain, allowing more to reach the brain and reducing some unwanted effects.

Bentall Procedure

Open-heart surgery that replaces a diseased aortic valve, the aortic root, and the first part of the aorta with a valve-containing tube graft. The coronary arteries are reattached to the graft. The replacement valve may be mechanical or biological, with different long-term implications.

Alternate Names:
Bentall Operation; Composite Aortic Root Replacement

Bent Penis

Curvature of the penis that may be present from birth or develop later. It can be painless or cause pain, difficulty with erection or intercourse, and sometimes problems passing urine.

Bent Spine Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Camptocormia*.

Benzaldehyde

A chemical with an almond-like smell used in flavourings, fragrances, and manufacturing. Concentrated exposure can irritate the eyes, skin, or lungs; it is not a routine medical treatment.

Benzazepines

A family of chemical structures made from joined benzene and seven-membered nitrogen-containing

rings. Individual compounds may have different biological or medicinal effects, so the family name alone does not identify a treatment.

Benzene

An industrial chemical and solvent found in some fuels and smoke. High short-term exposure can affect the brain and heart; repeated exposure can damage bone marrow and increase the risk of leukaemia.

Benzene Poisoning

Illness caused by breathing, swallowing, or absorbing benzene. Short-term exposure may cause dizziness, drowsiness, or irregular heartbeat; repeated exposure can damage bone marrow and increase the risk of leukaemia.

Benzhexol

Benzhexol, or trihexyphenidyl, is an anticholinergic drug used mainly to reduce tremor and rigidity in Parkinson disease or drug-induced extrapyramidal symptoms.

Benzo[a]pyrene

A polycyclic aromatic hydrocarbon (PAH) formed during the incomplete combustion of organic matter, including tobacco smoke, vehicle exhaust, and grilled meats. Its active metabolite, benzo[a]pyrene-7,8-dihydrodiol-9,10-epoxide (BPDE), forms mutagenic DNA adducts that drive chemical carcinogenesis.

Alternate Names:
BaP; 3,4-Benzopyrene; Benzo(a)pyrene

Benzoates

Salts or chemical forms of benzoic acid used mainly as food preservatives or ingredients in some products. Their effects and safety depend on the specific compound and amount; some people develop irritation or sensitivity.

Benzocaine

A local anaesthetic applied to skin or moist body surfaces to reduce sensation. Rarely, especially after excessive use, it can cause methemoglobinaemia, a condition in which blood cannot carry oxygen normally.

Benzodiazepine

A medicine that enhances the effect of the inhibitory chemical messenger GABA in the brain. It may reduce anxiety, induce sleep, relax muscles, or control seizures, but can cause sedation, impaired coordination, dependence, and dangerous breathing suppression when combined with opioids or other sedatives.

Benzodiazepine Toxicity

Excess benzodiazepine effect causing drowsiness, slurred speech, ataxia, impaired coordination, and sometimes coma or respiratory depression, especially with opioids or alcohol. Flumazenil can precipitate seizures or withdrawal in some settings.

Benzodiazepine Use Disorder

A pattern of benzodiazepine use that causes loss of control, harm, or problems at work, home, or in relationships. Regular use can cause dependence, and sudden stopping can produce life-threatening withdrawal.

Benzodiazepine Withdrawal

Symptoms after reducing or stopping regular benzodiazepine use. Anxiety, insomnia, shaking, sweating, and sensitivity to light may occur; severe withdrawal can cause seizures, hallucinations, or delirium.

Benzopyran

A chemical ring structure formed by joining benzene and pyran rings. It occurs in some natural substances and medicines; the term describes chemistry rather than one specific disease or treatment.

Benzopyrene

A group of chemicals produced by incomplete burning and found in tobacco smoke, vehicle exhaust, and heavily charred food. Some forms can damage DNA and increase cancer risk after the body changes them chemically.

Benzopyrenes

Plural form; see *Benzopyrene*.

Benzoyl Peroxide

A topical medicine that kills acne-causing bacteria and helps remove blocked skin cells. It can cause dryness, peeling, irritation, or bleaching of hair and fabrics.

Benzphetamine

A sympathomimetic amine and stimulant formerly used in some countries as a short-term adjunct for weight reduction; it can cause dependence, cardiovascular effects, and insomnia and is restricted or unavailable in many jurisdictions.

Benztropine

An anticholinergic medicine used mainly for movement problems caused by some medicines and for acute muscle spasms called dystonia. It can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, confusion, or worsen glaucoma.

Benzydamine

A topical anti-inflammatory pain-relieving medicine used for painful inflammation in the mouth, throat, or skin. It may cause temporary numbness, irritation, or an allergic reaction.

Benzylamines

Chemical compounds containing a benzyl group joined to an amino group. Some are used to make medicines or other chemicals, while their effects depend on the individual compound.

Benzyl Benzoate

A topical medicine used to kill mites that cause scabies and, in some settings, lice. It can irritate the skin.

Benzylpenicillin

A penicillin antibiotic used for serious infections caused by susceptible bacteria, including some streptococcal infections, meningitis, and syphilis. Allergic reactions can be severe.

BEP Regimen

A chemotherapy combination of bleomycin, etoposide, and cisplatin, commonly used for some germ-cell cancers. Important toxicities include low blood counts, infection, kidney damage, hearing changes, nerve symptoms, and lung injury.

Berberine

A plant compound sold in some supplements and studied for blood-sugar, cholesterol, and antimicrobial effects. Evidence varies, and it can cause stomach symptoms, low blood sugar, drug interactions, or harm during pregnancy.

Bereavement

The emotional response to the death of someone important. Grief may include sadness, yearning, anger, numbness, sleep or appetite changes, and waves of distress; it varies widely and can sometimes lead to prolonged grief or depression.

Bereavement Reaction

Emotional and physical responses after someone dies, such as sadness, disbelief, anger, poor sleep, or loss of appetite. These reactions are common and do not automatically indicate a mental disorder.

Berger Disease

An older name for IgA nephropathy, a kidney disease in which an immune protein builds up in kidney filters. It may cause episodes of blood in the urine after infections, protein in the urine, high blood pressure, and kidney failure.

Berger's Disease

Alternate name; see *IgA Nephropathy*.

Beriberi

Illness caused by severe vitamin B1 deficiency. It may damage nerves and cause weakness, numbness, or difficulty walking, or affect the heart and cause swelling, fast heartbeat, and heart failure.

Berloque Dermatitis

A phototoxic skin reaction caused when perfume or cosmetics containing psoralens, classically bergamot oil, are followed by ultraviolet-A exposure. It may

produce burning, redness, or blisters and then a pendant- or drip-shaped area of hyperpigmentation on the face or neck.

Bernard-Soulier Disease

Alternate name; see *Bernard-Soulier Syndrome*.

Bernard-Soulier Syndrome

A rare inherited bleeding disorder in which platelets are unusually large and do not work properly to stop bleeding. It usually involves a change in the platelet receptor that helps platelets attach to injured blood vessels. It can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy periods, or prolonged bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Glycoprotein Ib Deficiency; Platelet-Type Bleeding Disorder 1

Bernard–Soulier Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Bernard-Soulier Syndrome*.

Berry Aneurysm

A small, rounded balloon-like bulge at a branching point of an artery at the base of the brain. If it bursts, it can cause life-threatening bleeding around the brain.

Berylliosis

A long-term lung disease caused by sensitivity to inhaled beryllium dust or fumes. It can cause cough, breathlessness, fatigue, and scarring or inflammation that resembles sarcoidosis.

Beryllium

A light metal used in some industrial products. Breathing its dust or fumes can cause allergic lung inflammation, long-term lung disease, and increased cancer risk, especially after repeated workplace exposure.

Best Disease

An inherited macular disorder, usually caused by variants in BEST1, with abnormal accumulation of yellow material at the macula. Vision loss varies and may progress to atrophy, neovascularization, or scarring.

Beta 2-Microglobulin

A small protein released by most cells. Blood or urine levels may rise with inflammation, some blood cancers, or reduced kidney removal; the result is interpreted with symptoms and other tests.

Beta-Adrenoceptor-Blocking Drugs

Medicines that block adrenaline-like signals at beta receptors. They can slow the heart, lower blood pressure, reduce tremor, and protect the heart in selected conditions, but may cause fatigue, low pulse, or breathing problems in susceptible people.

Beta-Agonist

A pharmacological agent that stimulates beta-adrenergic receptors. Beta-2 selective agonists (such as albuterol and salmeterol) induce bronchial smooth muscle relaxation and bronchodilation in asthma and chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

Alternate Names:
Beta-Adrenergic Agonist

Beta-Alanine

An amino acid that helps muscles make carnosine, which buffers acid during intense activity. Supplements may modestly improve some short, high-intensity exercise but commonly cause temporary tingling of the skin.

Beta Amyloid

Small protein fragments made from amyloid precursor protein. They can build up into plaques in the brain and are associated with Alzheimer disease, although plaques alone do not explain every symptom.

Alternate Names:
Aβ Peptide; Amyloid-Beta Protein

Beta-Blockers

Alternate name; see *Beta-Adrenoceptor-Blocking Drugs*.

Beta-Blockers Overdose

Poisoning from taking too much of a beta-blocker. It can cause a very slow heartbeat, low blood pressure, wheezing, low blood sugar, confusion, seizures, or shock.

Beta-Blocker Toxicity

Poisoning that can cause slow heart rate, low blood pressure, atrioventricular block, cardiogenic shock, low blood sugar, bronchospasm, seizures, or altered mental status. Propranolol may also widen the QRS complex or cause seizures.

Beta Carotene

Alternate spelling; see *Beta-Carotene*.

Beta-Carotene

A plant-derived carotenoid and provitamin A pigment found in yellow, orange, and dark green leafy vegetables (such as carrots and spinach). In the intestinal mucosa, it is enzymatically cleaved into retinal. Excessive consumption can cause benign yellow-orange discoloration of the skin (carotenodermia, characteristically sparing the sclerae). Pharmacologic high-dose beta-carotene supplementation is contraindicated in smokers due to clinical trials demonstrating an increased risk of lung cancer.

Alternate Names:
Provitamin A Carotenoid; Carotenoid Provitamin

Beta-Carotene Blood Test

A blood test measuring beta-carotene, a plant pigment that can become vitamin A. A low result may suggest poor nutrition or fat absorption; a high result may cause harmless yellow-orange skin.

Beta Cell

A cell in the pancreas that makes and releases insulin when blood glucose rises. Insulin helps body cells use glucose and keeps blood glucose from becoming too high.

Alternate Names:
Beta Cells; Pancreatic Beta Cell; Pancreatic Beta Cells

Beta-Chemokines

Small immune signals that attract white blood cells to areas of infection or inflammation. They help coordinate defense, but excessive activity can contribute to long-lasting inflammation and tissue damage.

Betacoronavirus

A group of coronaviruses that includes viruses causing respiratory illnesses in people and animals. Individual viruses differ in spread and severity; some cause mild colds, while others can cause severe pneumonia.

Beta-Endorphin

A natural pain-relieving substance made in the brain and pituitary gland. It acts on opioid receptors and also influences stress responses, mood, and some hormone functions.

Beta Globulin

A group of blood proteins identified together during a protein blood test. They include proteins that carry iron or fats and support immunity; abnormal levels can occur with inflammation, liver disease, or immune disorders.

Beta Glucans

Alternate spelling; see *Beta-Glucans*.

Beta-Glucans

Complex carbohydrates found in foods such as oats, barley, mushrooms, and yeast. Their effects vary by source; some provide fibre and may modestly affect cholesterol, blood glucose, or immune activity.

Beta-Haemolytic Streptococcus

A streptococcus that completely breaks down red blood cells around its colonies in a laboratory culture. Important group A and group B species can cause throat, skin, bloodstream, newborn, or other serious infections.

Betaherpesvirinae

A subgroup of herpes viruses that includes cy-

tomegalovirus and human herpesviruses 6 and 7. They remain in the body after infection and can reactivate, especially when immunity is weakened.

Beta-Human Chorionic Gonadotrophin

The measurable part of the pregnancy hormone hCG. Blood or urine testing helps detect pregnancy and can help assess some pregnancy problems or selected tumours when interpreted with other findings.

Betaine

A natural substance involved in processing homocysteine and helping cells maintain their water balance. It is also sold as a supplement, but high doses can cause side effects or interact with medicines.

Beta Interferons

Immune-modifying medicines used to reduce relapses and new brain or spinal-cord lesions in some forms of multiple sclerosis. Common effects include flu-like symptoms and injection-site reactions; monitoring may detect liver or blood-count abnormalities.

Beta-Lactam Antibiotics

A large group of antibiotics that stop susceptible bacteria building their protective cell wall. They include penicillins, cephalosporins, carbapenems, and related medicines; allergic reactions and bacterial resistance can limit their use.

Beta-Lactamase

An enzyme made by some bacteria that breaks down certain penicillin-like antibiotics and makes them ineffective. Laboratory testing can identify this resistance, and some medicines block selected beta-lactamases.

Beta-Lactamase Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks selected bacterial beta-lactamase enzymes, helping a partner beta-lactam antibiotic resist breakdown. Inhibitors differ in structure, reversibility, and the enzymes they block; examples include clavulanate, sulbactam, tazobactam, and avibactam.

Beta-Mannosidosis

A rare autosomal recessive disorder in which cells cannot break down certain complex sugars. The stored material can cause developmental delay, hearing loss, repeated infections, seizures, or skeletal and skin problems.

Betamethasone

A strong corticosteroid medicine that reduces inflammation and immune activity. It may be applied to skin or given in other forms; prolonged or extensive use can thin the skin, worsen infections, or suppress the body's steroid production.

Betamethasone Valerate

A corticosteroid applied to the skin to reduce inflammation and itching in conditions such as eczema or psoriasis. Excessive, prolonged, or covered application can thin the skin and increase absorption into the body.

Beta-Oxidation

Alternate form; see *Fatty Acid Oxidation*.

Beta Particle

A fast-moving electron or positively charged equivalent released by some radioactive atoms. It can damage nearby tissue and is therefore used carefully in selected radiation treatments and laboratory applications.

Beta Radiation

Radiation made of fast electrons or their positively charged counterparts released by unstable atoms. It can injure living tissue but can also be directed at selected tissues for treatment or used in medical testing.

Beta-Sheet

A common folded shape in proteins in which extended strands lie beside one another and are held by chemical bonds. Excessive beta-sheet folding can contribute to abnormal protein deposits in some diseases.

Beta Thalassemia

An inherited disorder caused by reduced or absent production of beta-globin, usually due to pathogenic variants in the *HBB* gene. It causes microcytic anaemia of variable severity. A single affected gene usually causes carrier status with mild or no anaemia; variants affecting both copies can cause intermedia or severe major disease. Severe disease may cause ineffective red-cell production, splenomegaly, and bone changes.

Beta-Thalassemia

Alternate spelling; see *Beta Thalassemia*.

Beta-Thalassemia Intermedia

A moderately severe inherited form of beta-thalassemia causing ongoing anaemia, enlarged spleen, jaundice, or bone changes. People may need occasional transfusions, but usually do not require regular lifelong transfusions.

Beta-Thalassemia Major

The severe, usually transfusion-dependent form of beta-thalassemia caused by disease-causing variants in both copies of the *HBB* gene. The variants may abolish or reduce beta-globin production, leading to severe anemia because the bone marrow makes red blood cells poorly. Complications can include an enlarged spleen, bone changes, and iron overload.

Alternate Names:
Cooley Anemia

Beta-Thalassemia Minor

An inherited blood trait in which a person inherits one mutated gene for beta-globin, a protein needed to make hemoglobin in red blood cells. People with this condition produce slightly smaller red blood cells and may have mild anemia, but they typically have no symptoms and lead normal lives. Because their red blood cells are small, the condition is sometimes confused with iron-deficiency anemia, even though body iron levels are normal.

Alternate Names:
Beta-Thalassemia Trait; Cooley Trait; Thalassemia Minor

Beta-Thalassemia Trait

Alternate name; see *Beta-Thalassemia Minor*.

Beta Tocopherol

One naturally occurring form of vitamin E. It acts as a fat-soluble antioxidant, but the body generally uses alpha-tocopherol more effectively; its specific clinical importance is still being studied.

Betaxolol

A relatively beta-1-selective blocker used orally for some cardiovascular conditions and topically to lower intraocular pressure in glaucoma. It may cause bradycardia, hypotension, or bronchospasm.

Bethanechol

Bethanechol is a muscarinic cholinergic agonist that stimulates bladder and gastrointestinal smooth muscle, used selectively for urinary retention or impaired motility.

Bethesda System For Reporting Thyroid Cytopathology

A six-tier standardized system for reporting thyroid fine-needle aspiration results, from nondiagnostic and benign categories to follicular-pattern, suspicious, and malignant categories; each tier guides risk assessment and management.

Bethlem Myopathy

A usually slowly progressive inherited muscle disease caused by changes in collagen VI. It causes weakness, often beginning in childhood, together with tight joints or shortened muscles, especially in the fingers, elbows, ankles, or spine; many people remain able to walk into adulthood.

Alternate Names:
Collagen VI-Related Myopathy (Mild Form); Benign Congenital Myopathy with Contractures

Bevacizumab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks vascular endothelial growth factor and inhibits new blood-vessel formation. It is used for selected cancers and some eye diseases; important risks include hypertension,

bleeding, thrombosis, proteinuria, impaired wound healing, and gastrointestinal perforation.

Bexarotene

An oral retinoid X-receptor agonist used mainly for cutaneous T-cell lymphoma; it commonly causes hypertriglyceridaemia, hypothyroidism, and liver abnormalities and is teratogenic.

Bezafibrate

A fibrate lipid-lowering medicine that activates peroxisome proliferator-activated receptor alpha (PPAR-alpha) and lowers triglycerides. Adverse effects can include muscle injury and liver abnormalities.

Bezoar

A compact mass of material that cannot be digested and becomes trapped in the stomach or intestine. It may contain hair, plant matter, medicines, or other substances and can cause pain, vomiting, blockage, or bleeding.

Bezold-Jarisch Reflex

An inhibitory autonomic cardiovascular reflex characterized by the triad of profound bradycardia, peripheral vasodilation with severe hypotension, and transient apnea. It is triggered by the stimulation of non-myelinated vagal sensory C-fibers in the inferoposterior wall of the left ventricle by mechanical deformation, chemical agents, or acute ischemia during inferior myocardial infarction.

BH4 Deficiency

An inherited deficiency of tetrahydrobiopterin, a cofactor needed to process phenylalanine and make several neurotransmitters. It can cause high phenylalanine, seizures, movement or developmental problems, and neurologic disease; treatment depends on the specific defect.

B Hemophilia

Alternate name; see *Hemophilia B*.

Biacetyl

Biacetyl, or diacetyl, is a diketone compound with a buttery odor used in flavoring and industry; inhalational exposure can injure the small airways.

Bias

A systematic deviation that distorts a measurement, study result, clinical judgment, or decision away from the truth or from an intended fair comparison.

Bibliotherapy

The use of reading materials as a therapeutic intervention to support mental health, educate patients about conditions, or promote behavioral change. It may be used alone or alongside other treatments for depression, anxiety, or chronic disease self-management.

Bicalutamide

A non-steroidal androgen-receptor antagonist used in prostate cancer, usually with androgen-deprivation therapy; adverse effects include hot flushes, breast enlargement, sexual dysfunction, and possible liver injury.

Bicarbonate

A substance in the blood that helps keep the body's acid level balanced. The lungs and kidneys regulate it, and a blood bicarbonate result can help identify acid–base or metabolic problems.

Bicarbonate Buffer System

The primary extracellular chemical buffer system in the human body, consisting of carbonic acid and bicarbonate ion in equilibrium with dissolved carbon dioxide, regulated by the lungs (via carbon dioxide excretion) and the kidneys (via bicarbonate reabsorption and excretion).

Biceps

The biceps is a two-headed muscle, especially the biceps brachii of the upper arm, that flexes the elbow and supinates the forearm.

Biceps Brachii Muscle

The two-part muscle on the front of the upper arm. It bends the elbow, turns the palm upward, and helps lift the arm. Injury or tendon rupture can cause weakness, pain, bruising, or a bulging "Popeye" appearance.

Biceps Reflex

Bending of the elbow after the biceps tendon is gently tapped. This reflex tests the nerve supplying the biceps and the related spinal-cord pathways, mainly at the fifth and sixth neck levels.

Bicipital

Bicipital means relating to a two-headed muscle, especially the biceps tendon, groove, or muscle of the upper arm.

Bicipital Groove

The intertubercular groove of the humerus that transmits the tendon of the long head of the biceps brachii, with the transverse humeral ligament and adjacent rotator-cuff structures contributing to tendon stability.

Bicipital Tendinitis

Irritation and degeneration of the long-head biceps tendon near the shoulder, causing pain in the front of the shoulder that may worsen with lifting, reaching overhead, or resisted elbow flexion.

Bicipital Tuberosity

The radial tuberosity, a roughened prominence on the proximal radius where the biceps brachii tendon inserts and produces flexion and supination of the forearm.

Bickerstaff Brainstem Encephalitis

A rare autoimmune post-infectious central nervous system disorder closely related to the Miller Fisher variant of Guillain-Barré syndrome. It is characterized by the clinical triad of acute progressive ophthalmoplegia, severe ataxia, and central nervous system disturbance (altered consciousness or hyperreflexia), typically accompanied by serum anti-GQ1b IgG autoantibodies.

Bicolor

Having two distinct colours; the term may describe a structure such as an iris or a skin lesion.

Biconcave

Curved inward on both sides. Normal red blood cells have this disc shape, which makes them flexible and provides a large surface area for carrying oxygen.

Biconvex

Curved outward on both sides. The term may describe the shape of a lens, implant, anatomical structure, or finding on a scan.

Bicornuate

Having two horn-like cavities or projections. A bicornuate uterus is a congenital difference in which the upper uterus forms two partly separated spaces.

Bicornuate Uterus

A uterus with two upper cavities caused by incomplete joining during development before birth. Many people have no symptoms, but it can increase the risk of miscarriage, preterm birth, or abnormal baby position.

Alternate Names:
Bicornate Uterus

Bicuspid

Having two points or flaps. The term describes some teeth, which have two main points, and some heart valves, which have two flaps instead of the usual three.

Bicuspid Aortic Valve

A congenital aortic valve with two leaflets instead of the usual three. It can lead to aortic stenosis, aortic regurgitation, enlargement of the aorta, or other congenital heart abnormalities.

Bicuspid Valve

A valve with two leaflets. The normal mitral valve is bicuspid; in a congenital heart-valve disorder, the term usually refers to a bicuspid aortic valve, which has two leaflets instead of three. It may be

associated with aortic stenosis, regurgitation, or ascending-aortic enlargement.

Bid Protein

A protein that helps connect signals from outside a cell with programmed cell death inside it. When activated, it can help mitochondria release signals that lead to destruction of a damaged or unwanted cell.

Bielschowsky Head Tilt Test

A clinical diagnostic test used to evaluate trochlear nerve (cranial nerve IV) palsy causing superior oblique muscle paresis. Hypertropia and vertical diplopia worsen when the patient tilts the head toward the ipsilateral (paretic) side and improve when tilted toward the contralateral side, as the intact vestibular ocular reflex attempts intorsion.

Alternate Names:
Bielschowsky Phenomenon; Head Tilt Test

Biermer's Anemia

Another name for pernicious anaemia, in which the body cannot absorb enough vitamin B12 because the stomach does not provide the needed absorption factor. It causes anaemia and can damage nerves if untreated.

Bier Spots

Small, pale macules surrounded by an erythematous background on the extremities, typically elicited when the limbs are placed in a dependent position. They represent a benign physiological vascular anomaly caused by exaggerated local vasoconstriction in response to increased venous pressure and resolve upon limb elevation.

Bietti's Crystalline Dystrophy

A rare inherited eye disease in which tiny crystals and progressive damage develop in the retina and sometimes the cornea. It may cause difficulty seeing at night, loss of side vision, and gradual loss of central vision.

Bifascicular Block

An ECG finding in which electrical signals are delayed or blocked in two of the three main pathways carrying signals to the lower chambers of the heart. It usually combines right bundle branch block with a block in one of the left-sided pathways; its significance depends on symptoms and other heart findings.

Bifocal

Having two points of focus. Bifocal glasses contain one area for distance vision and another for near vision, allowing both prescriptions in one lens.

Bifurcation

The point where one body structure, blood vessel, airway, nerve, or pathway divides into two branches.

Bigeminy

A heart-rhythm pattern in which each underlying beat is followed by a premature beat, creating an alternating sequence. The premature beats may arise in the atria (atrial bigeminy) or ventricles (ventricular bigeminy). Bigeminy may cause palpitations or no symptoms.

Biglycan

A protein-and-sugar component of the tissue framework around cells. It helps organize collagen and may influence inflammation, wound healing, and blood-vessel changes.

Big Toe Sign

Upward movement of the big toe, sometimes with spreading of the other toes, when the sole is stroked. In an adult, this may suggest a problem in pathways connecting the brain and spinal cord.

Biguanide

A class of medications used to manage type 2 diabetes, most commonly represented by metformin. They lower blood sugar levels primarily by reducing the amount of glucose produced by the liver and improving the body's sensitivity to insulin, helping muscle cells take up glucose more effectively without causing low blood sugar on their own.

Alternate Names:
Biguanide Drugs; Biguanide Antidiabetics

Biguanides

Plural form; see *Biguanide*.

Bilateral

Affecting both sides of the body or both members of a paired structure, such as both eyes, ears, knees, lungs, or kidneys.

Bilateral Acoustic Neurofibromatosis

Older name for *NF2-Related Schwannomatosis*, a tumour-predisposition disorder characterized especially by bilateral vestibular schwannomas.

Bilateral Acoustic Neuroma

Tumours affecting both vestibular nerves, usually representing bilateral vestibular schwannomas associated with NF2-related schwannomatosis. They may cause hearing loss, tinnitus, balance problems, or other cranial-nerve symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Bilateral Vestibular Schwannoma; Bilateral Acoustic Neurinoma

Bilateral Ankle Swelling

Alternate form; see *Ankle Swelling*.

Bilateral Clubfoot

Clubfoot affecting both feet. Each foot turns downward and inward and may be stiff, with the heel and calf often smaller than usual. The deformity involves the foot and ankle and is present at birth.

Bilateral Gynecomastia

Enlargement of glandular breast tissue on both sides in a male. It may result from normal hormone changes, medicines, obesity, liver or kidney disease, or rarely cancer.

Bilateral Hydronephrosis

Enlargement of the urine-collecting spaces in both kidneys because urine cannot drain normally. Causes include blockage, reflux, stones, or bladder problems; prolonged obstruction can damage kidney function.

Bilateral Microphthalmos

A congenital condition in which both eyes are abnormally small. Vision may be reduced, and other ocular or developmental differences may occur. The degree of visual impairment varies with eye size and associated structural abnormalities.

Bilateral Oophorectomy

Surgery to remove both ovaries, sometimes performed for cancer, severe endometriosis, or high inherited cancer risk. Before natural menopause it causes immediate loss of ovarian hormones and infertility.

Bilateral Peritonsillar Abscesses

Collections of pus beside both tonsils, usually after a throat infection. They can cause severe sore throat, difficulty swallowing, trouble opening the mouth, muffled speech, and airway narrowing.

Bilateral Pneumonia

Infection or inflammation affecting both lungs. It may cause fever, cough, chest discomfort, breathlessness, or low oxygen; severity depends on the cause, extent, and person's health.

Bilateral Polycystic Ovarian Syndrome

Nonstandard name; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

Bilateral Sectoral Iris Heterochromia

A variation in iris pigmentation in which differently colored sectors occur within both irises. It may be present from birth or develop later.

Bilateral Tonic-Clonic Seizure

A seizure with loss of awareness, followed by stiffening and rhythmic jerking of both sides of the body. It may begin in both sides of the brain or spread to both sides from a focal onset.

Bile

An aqueous fluid produced continuously by the liver (about 600–1,000 mL daily) and carried through bile ducts. Most is diverted to the gallbladder between meals, where absorption of water and elec-

trolytes concentrates it, usually about fivefold and up to twentyfold. After a meal, cholecystokinin stimulates gallbladder contraction and delivery into the duodenum; secretin stimulates bicarbonate-rich ductal secretion. Bile contains bile salts, phospholipids, cholesterol, bilirubin, and electrolytes; bile salts emulsify fats and facilitate fat and fat-soluble-vitamin absorption.

Bile Acids

Substances made by the liver and released into the intestine to help digest and absorb fats and vitamins A, D, E, and K. Abnormal blood levels can indicate liver or bile-flow problems.

Bile Acid Sequestrants For Cholesterol

Medicines that trap bile acids in the intestine so they leave in stool. The liver then uses cholesterol to make more bile acids, lowering LDL cholesterol; constipation and medicine interactions are common concerns.

Bile Culture

A laboratory test that grows microorganisms from a bile sample to identify infection in the gallbladder or bile ducts and help select effective treatment.

Bile Duct

A tube that carries bile from the liver and gallbladder into the first part of the small intestine. Blockage or inflammation can prevent bile flow and cause pain, jaundice, infection, or pancreatitis.

Bile Duct Cancer

A malignancy arising in the bile ducts, also called cholangiocarcinoma. It is classified by location as intrahepatic, perihilar, or distal; extrahepatic tumors may obstruct bile flow and cause jaundice, dark urine, pale stools, itching, abdominal pain, or weight loss.

Alternate Names:
Cholangiocarcinoma

Bile Duct Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Bile Duct Cancer*.

Bile Duct Obstruction

A blockage that prevents bile moving from the liver or gallbladder into the intestine. It may cause jaundice, dark urine, pale stools, itching, abdominal pain, infection, or pancreatitis.

Bile Ducts

Plural form; see *Bile Duct*.

Bile Duct Stricture

Narrowing of a bile duct that slows or blocks bile flow. It may result from surgery, inflammation, stones, or cancer and can cause jaundice, pain, infection, or abnormal liver tests.

Bile Pigment

A coloured substance, mainly bilirubin, made when haemoglobin from old red blood cells is broken down. The liver processes it and excretes it in bile; build-up causes yellowing of the skin and eyes.

Bile Reflux

Backward flow of bile from the small intestine into the stomach and sometimes the esophagus. It may occur after stomach surgery or with impaired digestive movement and can contribute to irritation or inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Duodenogastric Reflux

Bile Reflux Gastritis

Inflammation of the stomach lining caused by backward flow of bile and other digestive juices from the small intestine. It can occur after stomach surgery or when normal digestive movement is impaired.

Alternate Names:
Alkaline Reflux Gastritis

Bile Salt Emulsification

The process in which bile salts break dietary fat into tiny droplets. This increases the surface area available to digestive enzymes and helps the intestine absorb fat and fat-soluble vitamins.

Bile Salt Malabsorption

Reduced reabsorption of bile acids in the small intestine, allowing excess bile acids to reach the colon and cause watery diarrhoea, urgency, or abdominal discomfort.

Alternate Names:
Bile Acid Diarrhea; Bile Acid Diarrhoea

Bile Salts

Substances made from cholesterol in the liver and released in bile. They help break fats into small droplets so the intestine can digest and absorb fats and vitamins A, D, E, and K.

Bile Secretion

Production and release of bile by liver cells into the bile canaliculi, followed by transport through the bile ducts and, between meals, storage and concentration in the gallbladder. Bile supports fat digestion and excretion of bilirubin and other substances.

Bilevel Positive Airway Pressure

Breathing support delivered through a mask, with higher air pressure when breathing in and lower pressure when breathing out. It can support breathing in conditions such as sleep apnoea or some lung and heart problems.

Bilharzia

An infection caused by Schistosoma parasites acquired when contaminated freshwater contacts the skin. It may affect the intestine, liver, urinary tract, or other organs and can cause long-term inflammation and scarring.

Biliary

Relating to bile, the gallbladder, or the tubes that carry bile from the liver to the intestine.

Biliary Atresia

A rare liver disorder in newborns and infants in which the bile ducts outside the liver are blocked, scarred, or missing. This prevents bile from draining from the liver into the intestines, causing bile to build up and damage liver tissue. Signs include prolonged jaundice (yellow skin and eyes), pale or clay-colored stools, and dark urine.

Biliary Calculi

Stones formed from hardened bile in the gallbladder or bile ducts. They may cause no symptoms or block bile flow, producing pain, jaundice, infection, or inflammation of the gallbladder or pancreas.

Biliary Cirrhosis

An older term for cirrhosis caused by long-standing bile-duct disease or obstruction. It was also formerly used for primary biliary cirrhosis, now called primary biliary cholangitis.

Biliary Colic

Steady upper-abdominal pain, usually in the right upper quadrant or epigastrium, caused by temporary blockage of the cystic duct or another bile duct, commonly by a gallstone. Despite the name, the pain is typically steady rather than cramping. It may follow a meal and last minutes to hours, easing when the obstruction clears; prolonged pain or fever may indicate a complication such as cholecystitis.

Biliary Decompression

A procedure that drains blocked bile ducts to restore bile flow. A doctor may place a stent or drainage tube through an endoscope or through the skin, depending on the cause and location of the blockage.

Biliary Dyskinesia

Gallbladder pain without gallstones or another obvious structural problem, often associated with abnormal emptying. Diagnosis requires typical symptoms and exclusion of other causes; a scan may help but is not decisive alone.

Biliary Fever

Fever associated with infection of the bile ducts or gallbladder. In acute cholangitis, fever may occur with upper-abdominal pain and jaundice, but the full combination is not always present.

Biliary Fistula

An abnormal passage allowing bile to leak from the gallbladder or bile ducts into another organ, the abdominal cavity, or the skin. It may cause pain, infection, bile drainage, or skin irritation.

Biliary Obstruction

Alternate name; see *Bile Duct Obstruction*.

Biliary Sand

Fine crystals or thick sludge suspended in bile, usually containing cholesterol, calcium salts, or pigment. It may disappear, form gallstones, block a duct, or cause gallbladder inflammation.

Biliary Scintigraphy

A nuclear medicine scan that uses a small amount of radioactive tracer to follow bile from the liver through the gallbladder and bile ducts into the small intestine. It can help assess gallbladder inflammation, bile leaks, or how well the gallbladder empties.

Alternate Names:
Cholescintigraphy; HIDA Scan; Hepatobiliary Scintigraphy; Hepatobiliary Iminodiacetic Acid Scan

Biliary Stasis

Alternate name; see *Cholestasis*.

Biliary Stent

A small tube placed inside a bile duct to keep it open and allow bile to drain when it is narrowed or blocked. Stents can move, clog, or cause infection or pancreatitis.

Biliary System

The liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts that make, store, and carry bile into the small intestine to help digest fats.

Biliary Tract

The network of ducts carrying bile from the liver and gallbladder to the small intestine. Blockage or inflammation can cause upper-abdominal pain, jaundice, infection, or pancreatitis.

Biliary Tract Biopsy

A procedure to collect cells or a small tissue sample from a bile duct or the gallbladder for laboratory examination. A doctor may collect it during an endoscopic procedure or through the skin using imaging.

Biliary Tract Injuries

Damage to the gallbladder or bile ducts, often after abdominal surgery or trauma. Bile may leak or drainage may become blocked, causing abdominal pain, jaundice, infection, or later narrowing.

Biliary Tree

Alternate name; see *Biliary Tract*.

Bili Lights

Special blue-green light used in phototherapy to change bilirubin in a newborn's skin into forms that can be eliminated more easily. Phototherapy lowers bilirubin and helps prevent bilirubin-related brain injury.

Bilious

Containing or relating to bile. Bilious vomit is usually yellow or green because bile has entered the stomach contents.

Bilious Vomiting

Vomiting green or yellow fluid containing bile. In a newborn or infant, clearly green vomit can indicate bowel blockage.

Bilirubin

A yellow substance made mainly when old red blood cells are broken down. The liver changes it and sends it into bile; too much bilirubin in the blood causes yellowing of the skin and eyes.

Bilirubin Blood Test

A blood test that measures bilirubin, a yellow substance made as old red blood cells break down. The result can help identify problems with red blood cells, the liver, or bile flow. In newborns, it helps assess the risk of bilirubin-related brain injury.

Bilirubin Encephalopathy

Brain injury caused by very high levels of unconjugated bilirubin, especially in newborns. Early signs may include poor feeding, sleepiness, weak or stiff muscles, and seizures; permanent injury is called kernicterus.

Bilirubin Metabolism

The process by which the body makes bilirubin from old red blood cells, carries it to the liver, changes it into a water-soluble form, and removes it in bile and stool.

Bilirubin Test

A blood test measuring total and direct (conjugated) bilirubin levels to assess liver function, biliary tract patency, and red blood cell breakdown (hemolysis); see *Bilirubin*.

Bilirubinuria

The presence of conjugated (direct), water-soluble bilirubin in urine. It may occur when liver dysfunction or blocked bile flow raises conjugated bilirubin in the blood and can make urine appear unusually dark.

Biliverdin

A green pigment formed when haemoglobin is broken down. The body normally converts it into bilirubin, which the liver processes and removes in bile.

Billroth I

A surgical procedure for partial gastrectomy in which the distal stomach (antrum and pylorus) is resected and the remaining proximal gastric remnant is anastomosed directly to the duodenum (gastroduodenostomy).

Alternate Names:
Billroth I Reconstruction; Gastroduodenostomy

Billroth II

A surgical procedure for partial gastrectomy in which the distal stomach is resected, the duodenal stump is closed, and the remaining gastric remnant is anastomosed to a loop of the proximal jejunum (gastrojejunostomy), leaving a blind duodenal limb for biliopancreatic drainage.

Alternate Names:
Billroth II Reconstruction; Gastrojejunostomy

Billroth II Operation

A surgical reconstruction procedure following partial gastrectomy in which the duodenal stump is oversewn closed and the gastric remnant is anastomosed directly to the side of a loop of proximal jejunum (gastrojejunostomy).

Billroth I Operation

A surgical reconstruction procedure following partial gastrectomy (antrectomy) in which the remaining gastric remnant is anastomosed directly to the duodenal stump (gastroduodenostomy).

Billroth's Operation

An older type of partial stomach-removal surgery. In Billroth I the remaining stomach is joined to the duodenum; in Billroth II it is joined to the jejunum, a later part of the small intestine.

Bilophila

A group of bacteria that can live without oxygen in the human intestine. Most are harmless there, but Bilophila wadsworthia has been found in some appendicitis, abdominal, wound, and bloodstream infections.

Bilophila Wadsworthia

A bacterium that tolerates bile and normally occurs in small numbers in the colon. If intestinal bacteria enter damaged or normally sterile tissue, it may contribute to appendicitis, abdominal infection, or wound infection.

Bimanual

Performed using both hands. A bimanual pelvic examination uses one hand inside the vagina and the other on the abdomen to assess pelvic organs.

Bimatoprost

Bimatoprost is a prostaglandin analogue used as eye drops to lower intraocular pressure and, in some formulations, promote eyelash growth.

Bimedial

Describing the medial, or midline-facing, sides of two structures. It identifies a relative position, so the structures being compared must be specified.

Bimellar

Made of two thin layers or plates. The term describes the structure of a membrane, tissue, or other object and has no disease meaning by itself.

Binary Fission

A form of reproduction in which one cell divides into two genetically similar cells. It is common among bacteria and many single-celled organisms.

Binder Excipient

An inactive ingredient added during tablet manufacture to help powder particles stick together. It has no intended treatment effect but affects the tablet's strength and breakdown.

Binding Protein

A protein that attaches specifically to another molecule, such as a hormone, medicine, nutrient, DNA segment, or cell-surface signal. Binding can transport, store, activate, or block the other molecule.

Binding Site

The particular area of a molecule where another molecule attaches. The interaction can change activity, transmit a signal, allow transport, or enable a laboratory test to detect the target.

Binet-Simon Scale

An early intelligence test for children that compared performance with tasks expected at different ages. It influenced modern cognitive testing but is no longer the standard tool for clinical assessment.

Binge Drinking

An episode of heavy alcohol use. The CDC defines it as four or more standard drinks for women or five or more for men on one occasion; this amount typically raises blood alcohol concentration to 0.08

Alternate Names:
Episodic Heavy Drinking; Heavy Episodic Drinking

Binge Eating Disorder

Alternate form; see *Binge-Eating Disorder*.

Binge-Eating Disorder

An eating disorder involving recurrent episodes of consuming an unusually large amount of food in a discrete period with a sense of loss of control and marked distress. Episodes occur at least once a week for three months and are not regularly followed by compensatory behaviors such as vomiting, fasting, or excessive exercise. Body weight alone does not establish the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
BED

Binge-Purge Disorder

An older or patient-facing name for bulimia nervosa, an eating disorder involving recurrent binge eating followed by compensatory behaviors such as self-induced vomiting, fasting, or excessive exercise.

Binocular Vision

The use of both eyes together to produce one image and judge depth. Misalignment or poor coordination between the eyes can cause double vision, eyestrain, or reduced depth perception.

Alternate Names:
Two-Eyed Vision; Binocular Visual Function

Binocular Visual Loss

Reduced vision affecting both eyes. Causes may involve the eyes, optic nerves, brain, or visual pathways; sudden loss with weakness, speech trouble, or severe headache may indicate an acute neurologic disorder.

Binswanger Disease

A form of small-vessel disease in the brain that damages deep white matter. It can cause gradually worsening thinking, walking difficulty, mood changes, and urinary problems.

Binswanger's Dementia

A form of vascular cognitive impairment caused by diffuse small-vessel disease affecting the brain's deep white matter.

Alternate Names:
Subcortical Ischemic Vascular Disease; Subcortical Arteriosclerotic Encephalopathy

Bioabsorbable Vascular Stent

A temporary endovascular scaffold constructed from biodegradable polymers (such as poly-L-lactic acid) or bioresorbable metallic alloys (such as magnesium) engineered to provide vessel patency during vascular remodeling before undergoing hydrolytic degradation and systemic resorption.

Alternate Names:
Bioabsorbable Vascular Scaffold; BVS; Bioresorbable Stent; BRS

Bioaccumulation

The gradual build-up of a substance in an organism when absorption is faster than removal. Pollutants, medicines, and metals can accumulate in tissues and may cause harm when levels become high.

Bioactive

Having an effect on living cells, tissues, or organisms, such as a bioactive drug, hormone, nutrient, or signaling molecule.

Bioassay

A test that measures the effect or activity of a substance by observing its action on living cells, tissues, organisms, or a biological system. It can be used to estimate potency, toxicity, or biologic activity.

Bioavailability

The fraction of an administered dose that reaches the systemic circulation in an active form, and the rate at which it does so. It depends on the route, absorption, and first-pass metabolism; intravenous administration has 100

Bioburden

The number and types of living microorganisms present on a surface, medical device, tissue, or medicine before sterilization. Testing it helps confirm that cleaning and sterilization methods are adequate.

Biochanin A

A naturally occurring isoflavone found mainly in legumes and other plants. It is studied for biologic effects but is not established as a treatment for disease.

Alternate Names:
Biochanin a Isoflavone; 5,7-Dihydroxy-4'-Methoxyisoflavone

Biochemical

Relating to the chemical substances and reactions that occur in living organisms, including metabolism and cellular signaling.

Biochemical Assessment

Evaluation of the body's chemical state using measurements in blood, urine, or other samples. Depending on the purpose, tests may measure glucose, salts, proteins, hormones, or nutrients to assess metabolism, nutrition, or organ function.

Biochemical Reaction

A chemical change occurring in a living cell or body, usually controlled by enzymes. It may build or break down molecules and supports energy production, growth, repair, and normal organ function.

Biochemical Recurrence

A rise in a disease-associated blood marker after treatment, before recurrence is visible on imaging or causes symptoms. In prostate cancer, it refers to a rise in prostate-specific antigen (PSA) after surgery or radiation; the threshold used depends on the treatment.

Alternate Names:
Biochemical Relapse; Biochemical Failure

Biochemistry

The study of the chemical substances and reactions occurring in living organisms. Clinical biochemistry uses laboratory measurements to assess health and disease.

Biocompatibility

The ability of a material or device to perform its intended function without causing an unacceptable harmful reaction in body tissues.

Biodegradable Implant

An implant designed to provide support temporarily and then gradually break down into substances the body can process or remove. Its safety depends on how quickly it breaks down and how tissues respond.

Biodistribution

The way a medicine, tracer, or other substance spreads through the blood and different organs over time. It affects where treatment acts, how well an image is produced, and radiation or toxicity to healthy tissue.

Bioengineering

The application of engineering principles to biology and medicine, including the design of medical devices, biomaterials, tissue-engineering systems, prostheses, and diagnostic technologies.

Bioequivalence

A finding that two versions of a medicine enter the bloodstream at a similar rate and amount when given at the same dose. It supports the expectation of comparable effects and safety for approved uses.

Bioethics

The study of moral questions in medicine, biology, research, and healthcare technology. It considers consent, privacy, fairness, benefit, harm, quality of life, and respect for patients and communities.

Biofeedback

A technique that shows information about a body function, such as muscle tension, heart rate, or breathing, so a person can learn to control it. It may support treatment of selected pain, stress, or movement problems.

Biofilm

A community of microorganisms attached to a surface and surrounded by a protective material they produce. Biofilms can form on teeth, wounds, catheters, and implants and may be difficult to remove.

Biofilm-Associated Infections

Infections caused by microorganisms living in a protective layer on tissue, wounds, teeth, or medical devices. Biofilms can make organisms more tolerant of antibiotics and host defenses, allowing infection to persist.

Biofluid

A fluid from a living body, such as blood, urine, saliva, spinal fluid, or joint fluid. Biofluids can be tested for cells, chemicals, microorganisms, medicines, or signs of disease.

Bio-Informatics

The use of computers and statistics to store, compare, and interpret biological information such as DNA sequences, genes, proteins, and medical data.

Biological

Relating to living organisms, their parts, functions, processes, or products. In medicine, a biological product is made from or resembles a substance from a living source.

Biological Availability

The amount and speed at which a medicine or other substance becomes available to produce an effect in the body. It depends on the route, absorption, breakdown, and removal of the substance.

Biological Clock

The body's internal timing system that helps coordinate daily sleep, alertness, hormone release, body temperature, and other repeating functions in response to light and other environmental signals.

Biological Half-Life

The time needed for the body to remove half of a medicine or other substance through metabolism and excretion. It differs from the physical half-life of a radioactive substance and helps guide dosing or safety decisions.

Biological Model

A cell, tissue, organism, computational system, or other representation used to study biological mechanisms, disease, or treatment responses.

Biological Process

A coordinated series of molecular, cellular, or physiological events in a living organism, such as metabolism, cell division, inflammation, or tissue repair.

Biological Relative

A person who shares genetic ancestry with someone. Family medical history uses biological relatives to assess inherited risks, while relatives by marriage or legal relationship do not share that genetic information.

Biological Therapy

Alternate name; see *Biologic Therapy*.

Biological Transport

The movement of substances such as water, salts, nutrients, medicines, or cells within the body or across cell membranes. It may occur by diffusion, channels, pumps, filtration, or transport vesicles.

Biological Valve

A prosthetic heart valve made from animal or donated human tissue. Compared with mechanical valves, it is less likely to require lifelong anticoagulation solely because of the valve, but it may wear out and need replacement.

Alternate Names:
Bioprosthetic Valve; Tissue Valve

Biological Variability

Alternate name; see *Biologic Variation*.

Alternate Names:
Biologic Variation; Physiologic Variability

Biological Warfare

The deliberate use of microorganisms, toxins, or other biological agents to cause illness, death, or disruption in people, animals, or plants.

Biologic Therapy

Treatment with a medicine or other product made from living organisms or their components. Biologic treatments include monoclonal antibodies, cytokines, vaccines, and cell-based therapies; they can target specific cells or molecules or change immune activity. Uses include some cancers and inflammatory or autoimmune diseases.

Biologic Therapy In Dermatology

Treatment of skin disease with biologic medicines, most often antibodies or receptor proteins that block specific immune signals, such as tumor necrosis factor or interleukins. These medicines are used for conditions including moderate-to-severe psoriasis, atopic dermatitis, and hidradenitis suppurativa; infection is a possible risk.

Biologic Variation

Natural fluctuation in a body measurement within one person over time or between different people. It may reflect physiologic rhythms, age, diet, or other factors and can affect interpretation of laboratory results or changes during illness.

Bioluminescence

Light produced by a living organism through a chemical reaction. It is used by some organisms for communication or defense and is used in laboratories to detect biological activity.

Biomarker

A measurable feature that gives information about a normal body process, disease, likely outcome, or response to treatment. It may be measured in blood, tissue, genes, images, or other samples.

Biomarker Testing

Laboratory testing of genes, proteins, metabolites, or other measurable features to help identify disease, estimate likely outcome, choose treatment, or monitor response.

Biomaterial

A natural or manufactured material designed to contact or interact with the body. Examples include implant surfaces, artificial joints, wound dressings, prostheses, and materials that release medicines.

Biomechanical Compliance

How easily a body structure changes size or shape when pressure or force is applied. Lung and blood-vessel compliance affect breathing and circulation, while joint compliance affects movement and stability.

Biomechanics

The study of how forces and movement affect the body. It examines walking, posture, joints, muscles, and loads to understand injury, improve rehabilitation, or design supportive devices.

Biomedical Cement

A medical material used to fill gaps, stabilize broken bone, anchor an implant, or repair tissue. Its use and strength depend on the procedure and the tissue being treated.

Biomedical Device

An instrument, implant, software system, or other product intended to diagnose, monitor, prevent, or treat disease or injury. Its safety and usefulness depend on proper design, testing, maintenance, and correct use.

Biomedical Engineering

The use of engineering, materials, computing, and design to create or improve medical devices, diagnostic tests, implants, prostheses, imaging systems, and other healthcare technologies.

Biomedical Tape

Adhesive tape designed for medical use, such as securing dressings, tubes, sensors, or small devices. Different types vary in strength, flexibility, water resistance, and risk of skin irritation.

Biomedicine

Medicine grounded in the biological sciences, including the study of disease mechanisms, diagnosis, prevention, and treatment through laboratory and clinical research.

Biometry

Measurement of body structures or functions. In eye care, optical biometry measures the eye to help calculate the strength of an artificial lens before cataract surgery.

Biomicroscopy

Examination of living tissue with a microscope. In eye care, a slit lamp provides magnified views of the cornea, front chamber, lens, and other eye structures.

Biomolecule

A molecule made by or found in living organisms, such as a protein, fat, sugar, DNA, or RNA. Biomolecules provide structure, energy, information, and control of cell functions.

Biomonitoring

Repeatedly measuring substances or body changes over time using blood, urine, breath, hair, or other samples. It can assess exposure to poisons or medicines, treatment levels, hormones, or disease activity.

Biomphalaria

A group of freshwater snails that can carry the par-

asite Schistosoma mansoni. The parasite develops in the snails and can later infect people who contact contaminated freshwater.

Bionics

The use of electronic or mechanical devices to replace or support body functions, such as hearing, movement, or sensation. Examples include cochlear implants, powered prostheses, and other assistive systems.

Biophotonics

The use of light to study, diagnose, monitor, or treat living tissues and biological processes. Examples include optical imaging, fluorescence testing, laser surgery, and photodynamic therapy.

Biophysical Profile

A pregnancy assessment combining fetal-heart-rate monitoring with ultrasound. It checks fetal movement, breathing movements, muscle tone, and amniotic-fluid volume to help assess fetal well-being.

Bioprinting

An additive-manufacturing method that places living cells, biomaterials, and biologically active molecules in controlled patterns to build tissue-like constructs. It supports tissue-engineering research, disease models, and regenerative medicine; most constructs remain experimental and do not reproduce the full function of complex organs.

Alternate Names:
3D Bioprinting; Three-Dimensional Bioprinting

Biopsy

Removal of cells, fluid, or tissue from a living body for laboratory examination to diagnose disease, including cancer. A biopsy may collect a small sample or remove an entire suspicious area. Methods include fine-needle aspiration, core-needle, incisional, excisional, punch, and endoscopic biopsy; risks such as pain, bleeding, or infection depend on the site and procedure.

Biopsy Lung

Removal of a small lung-tissue sample using a needle, bronchoscope, or operation. Examination can investigate infection, inflammation, scarring, or cancer; the method depends on the lesion and procedural risks.

Biopsy Needle

A needle used to remove cells or tissue for laboratory examination. A fine needle usually collects loose cells, while a core needle removes a small cylinder that preserves the tissue's arrangement.

Biopsy Site

The body location from which cells or tissue are removed for testing. It is chosen to sample the abnormal area while limiting injury to nearby organs, nerves, and blood vessels.

Biopsy Specimen

Cells or tissue removed from the body for laboratory examination. Microscopy, special stains, immune tests, or genetic tests may be used to identify cancer, infection, inflammation, or another condition.

Biosafety

Practices, equipment, and containment methods used to prevent accidental exposure to or release of infectious organisms, biological materials, or toxins.

Biosafety Level

A classification describing the laboratory facilities, equipment, work practices, and protective measures needed to handle biological agents safely according to their risk.

Biosecurity

Measures that prevent biological agents or toxins from being accidentally or deliberately released, stolen, or misused. It includes secure facilities, controlled access, staff training, risk assessment, and responsible handling of biological materials.

Biosensor

A device that uses a biological material to recognize a substance and a detector to measure it. Medical examples include sensors for glucose, hormones,

infectious organisms, or heart-related markers.

Biosimilar

A biological medicine highly similar to an already approved biological medicine, with no meaningful differences in safety or effectiveness for approved uses. Because these medicines are complex, similarity is shown through comparative testing.

Biospecimen

A sample of human tissue, cells, blood, urine, or another body fluid collected for laboratory testing or research.

Biostatistics

The use of statistics to plan medical studies, analyse health data, measure uncertainty, and interpret evidence about disease, diagnosis, prevention, and treatment.

Biosynthesis

The process by which living cells use enzymes and energy to build complex molecules from simpler substances, such as making proteins from amino acids.

Biot Breathing

An irregular breathing pattern with unpredictable changes in breath depth and timing, sometimes interrupted by pauses. Medical sources use the name inconsistently: some call it ataxic breathing, while others distinguish it from cluster breathing. It may occur with severe brainstem disease.

Biotechnology

The use of living cells, organisms, or biological molecules to develop products and processes such as vaccines, biological medicines, genetic tests, and gene therapies.

Biotelemetry

Measuring and sending body information from a person or animal to a distant receiver. It can be used for heart-rhythm, temperature, breathing, glucose, or intensive-care monitoring.

Bioterrorism

The deliberate release of infectious organisms, toxins, or other biological agents to cause illness, death, fear, or disruption. Response involves rapid detection, public-health coordination, protection, testing, isolation when needed, and treatment or prevention.

Bioterrorism Agents

Infectious organisms or toxins that could be deliberately released to cause widespread illness or panic. Public-health authorities prepare for agents causing anthrax, smallpox, botulism, plague, tularemia, or severe viral haemorrhagic fever.

Biotherapy

Treatment using living organisms, cells, genes, or biological substances to prevent or treat disease. Immunotherapy, some cell therapies, and selected biological medicines are forms of biotherapy.

Biotin

A water-soluble B vitamin needed by enzymes involved in processing fats, sugars, and amino acids. Deficiency is uncommon but can cause rash, hair loss, weakness, or neurologic symptoms; high-dose supplements can interfere with some laboratory tests, including hormone and cardiac-marker assays.

Biotinidase Deficiency

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot recycle biotin efficiently. Untreated deficiency can cause seizures, developmental problems, hearing or vision loss, skin rash, and weakness; biotin treatment prevents or limits these complications.

Biotin Vitamin B7

Alternate name; see *Biotin*.

Biotinylation

The attachment of biotin to another molecule, usually a protein, so it can be found or separated in a laboratory test. The biotin acts as a tag that binds to special substances, making the target easier to detect or collect. Biotinylation can occur naturally or be done artificially.

Biotransformation

The natural process by which the body changes drugs and other foreign substances, mainly through enzymes in the liver but also in other tissues. It often makes them less active and easier to remove. Phase I reactions modify the substance; phase II reactions may attach another molecule to help eliminate it. These steps are not always sequential, and the process can produce an active or harmful substance instead.

Biotrauma

Inflammation caused by mechanical injury to the lungs during breathing-machine treatment. Inflammatory signals can spread through the body and contribute to organ injury.

Biot's Breathing

Alternate spelling; see *Biot Breathing*.

BiPAP

Alternate name; see *Bilevel Positive Airway Pressure*.

BiPAP Machine

A device that delivers two levels of breathing pressure through a mask—higher during inhalation and lower during exhalation. Settings are prescribed and adjusted according to the person's breathing problem and response.

Biparental

Involving both biological parents. In genetics, biparental inheritance means that a child receives relevant genetic material from both the mother and the father.

Biparietal Diameter

The width of a baby's head measured by ultrasound from one side to the other. It helps estimate pregnancy age and monitor growth, but is interpreted with other measurements because head shape can affect the result.

Bipartite Ossification

Formation or persistence of two separate ossification centers in a bone. If they do not fuse, a bipartite bone, such as a bipartite patella, may result. This is usually an incidental developmental variant but can become painful after injury or repetitive stress.

Biphasic Reaction

A reaction in which symptoms return after an allergic reaction has fully settled, without another exposure to the trigger. It is often discussed with anaphylaxis, a severe allergic reaction, and may begin hours after the first episode. The returning symptoms may be similar to or different from the first ones.

Biphenyl Compounds

Chemicals made of two linked benzene rings. Polychlorinated biphenyls (PCBs) are long-lasting industrial pollutants; exposure can harm the liver, immune system, and hormone system and may increase cancer risk.

Bipolar

Alternate name; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Bipolar Affective Disorder

Alternate name; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Bipolar Disorder

A mental health condition involving episodes of unusually high or irritable mood and energy, and often episodes of depression. Bipolar I includes at least one manic episode; depression may or may not occur. Bipolar II includes hypomania, a less severe high-mood episode, and major depression. Cyclothymia is a related condition with longer-lasting, milder mood highs and lows that do not reach the level of full manic or depressive episodes.

Bipolar Disorder in Child and Teens

Bipolar disorder diagnosed in childhood or adolescence, involving episodes of mania or hypomania and, in some forms, major depression. Bipolar I requires a manic episode; depression is not required. Symptoms may overlap with other psychiatric or de-

velopmental conditions, so diagnosis considers their duration, pattern, and functional effect.

Bipolar I Disorder

A mood disorder defined by at least one manic episode lasting at least seven days or requiring hospitalization. A manic episode is a distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood and increased goal-directed activity or energy.

Bipolar II Disorder

A mood disorder characterized by at least one hypomanic episode and at least one major depressive episode, with no history of a full manic episode. The combination of hypomania and depression can cause substantial distress or impairment even though hypomania is less severe than mania.

Bipolaris

A genus of fungi found mainly in soil and plants. Some species can rarely cause eye, sinus, skin, or invasive infections, particularly in people with reduced immunity. Species are identified by laboratory culture or molecular testing.

Bipolar Neuron

A bipolar neuron has one dendrite and one axon extending from opposite sides of its cell body, as found in the retina and sensory pathways.

Birbeck Granules

Small rod- or tennis-racket-shaped structures found inside Langerhans cells. They are associated with these cells but are not by themselves proof of Langerhans cell histiocytosis.

Bird Fancier's Lung

A form of hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by breathing proteins from bird feathers or droppings. It can cause cough and shortness of breath; repeated exposure may lead to permanent lung scarring.

Bird Flu

Common name; see *Avian Influenza*.

Birefringence

The optical property of a material in which light travels at different speeds along different axes, changing its polarization and sometimes splitting it into two rays. Polarized-light microscopy uses birefringence to identify crystals and other ordered structures in tissues or body fluids.

Birefringent

Describing a material that exhibits birefringence. See also: *Birefringence*.

Birth

The process by which a baby leaves the uterus, including labour, delivery of the baby, and delivery of the placenta.

Birth Asphyxia

Failure to establish or maintain effective breathing and oxygen supply around birth. It can injure the brain or other organs and may cause neonatal encephalopathy, but is not the same diagnosis.

Birth Control

Methods used to prevent pregnancy, including condoms, pills, implants, injections, intrauterine devices, fertility-awareness methods, and permanent procedures. Choice depends on effectiveness, health, side effects, future plans, access, and personal preference.

Birth Control And Family Planning

Planning whether and when to have children using contraception, fertility care, pregnancy advice, and reproductive health services. Care respects personal choices and considers health conditions, safety, goals, and informed consent.

Birth Control Methods

Birth-control methods include condoms, pills, implants, injections, intrauterine devices, patches, rings, fertility-awareness approaches, and permanent contraception. Effectiveness, sexually transmitted infection protection, side effects, reversibility, and medical eligibility vary by method.

Birth Control Pill Overdose

Illness after taking too many contraceptive tablets. Most exposures cause little or no serious harm, but nausea, vomiting, drowsiness, or other symptoms may occur, and the product and amount taken help guide management.

Birth Control Pills

Hormonal tablets used to prevent pregnancy, usually by stopping ovulation, thickening cervical mucus, or changing the uterine lining. They do not protect against sexually transmitted infections.

Birth Defect

A structural or functional condition that originates during prenatal development and is present at birth, although it may not be recognized until later. Causes include genetic or chromosomal changes, infection, maternal illness, nutritional deficiency, or environmental exposures; many cases have no identified cause.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Anomaly; Congenital Anomalies; Congenital Malformation; Congenital Disorder

Birth Defects

Alternate name; see *Birth Defect*.

Birth Defects Testing

Prenatal or newborn testing used to screen for or diagnose structural, genetic, chromosomal, metabolic, or functional conditions present at birth. Tests may include ultrasound, serum screening, cell-free DNA, diagnostic procedures, and newborn screening.

Birth Injury

Physical harm to a newborn during labour or delivery. It may affect the skin, bones, nerves, muscles, or brain and can result from difficult delivery, the baby's position, or medical complications.

Birth Trauma

Physical injury sustained by a neonate during mechanical labor and delivery; see *Birth Injury*.

Birthmark

A congenital cutaneous irregularity or lesion present at birth or appearing within early infancy, categorized into vascular anomalies (e.g., infantile hemangiomas, port-wine stains/capillary malformations, salmon patches) and pigmented lesions (e.g., congenital melanocytic nevi, café-au-lait macules, dermal melanocytosis). Most are benign; rapid enlargement, ulceration, bleeding, or anatomical compromise of the visual axis or airway warrants specialist evaluation.

Birthmarks

Plural form; see *Birthmark*.

Birthmarks And Other Skin Pigmentation Problems

A broad term for marks present at birth or early in life and for later changes in skin colour. Examples include vascular birthmarks, pigmented moles, post-inflammatory darkening, and vitiligo, in which areas of skin lose pigment. The term covers several distinct findings rather than one diagnosis.

Birt-Hogg-Dube Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Birt-Hogg-Dubé Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
BHD Syndrome

Birt-Hogg-Dubé Syndrome

An inherited condition caused by a change in the FLCN gene. It can cause small, usually harmless skin growths, cysts in the lungs with repeated collapsed lung, and an increased risk of kidney tumors. It is autosomal dominant, meaning one altered copy of the gene can cause the condition.

Birt-Hogg-Dube Syndrome (BHDS)

Alternate spelling and abbreviation; see *Birt-Hogg-Dubé Syndrome*.

Birth Pains

Birth pains are painful uterine contractions and related pressure during labor as the cervix dilates and the baby moves through the birth canal.

Birth Rate

The number of live births in a population during a specified period, usually expressed per 1,000 people per year.

Birth Spacing

The interval between successive pregnancies or births. Specify the measure: the interpregnancy interval runs from a birth to conception of the next pregnancy, while the birth-to-birth interval runs from one live birth to the next. These intervals are related but not interchangeable.

Alternate Names:
Child Spacing; Pregnancy Spacing

Birth Weight

The first weight recorded after birth; for a liveborn infant, it is preferably measured within the first hour, before significant postnatal weight loss. Low birth weight is less than 2,500 g regardless of gestational age; very low birth weight is less than 1,500 g, and extremely low birth weight is less than 1,000 g. These are overlapping categories, and lower birth weight is associated with greater risk of neonatal complications.

Bisacodyl

A stimulant laxative that increases bowel movement and helps empty the bowel. It is used short term for constipation or before some procedures; cramps, diarrhoea, and dehydration can occur.

Bisexual

Describes a person who may feel romantic or sexual attraction to people of more than one gender. It refers to an identity or orientation, not a disease or disorder.

Bisexuality

A sexual orientation involving possible romantic or sexual attraction to people of more than one gender. People experience this attraction in different ways; bisexuality is not a disease or disorder.

Bishop Score

A score used before inducing labour to describe how ready the cervix is for birth. It considers opening, thinning, softness, position, and the baby's head position; a higher score generally predicts an easier induction.

Bis In Die

Latin for "twice daily," traditionally abbreviated b.i.d. It is an older prescription abbreviation for a dosing frequency.

Bismuth

A metal used in some medicines and industrial products. Certain bismuth compounds can soothe diarrhoea or stomach symptoms, but excessive or prolonged exposure can cause nervous-system or kidney toxicity.

Bisoprolol

A beta-1-selective blocker used to treat hypertension, angina, and selected patients with heart failure. It lowers heart rate and blood pressure and may cause bradycardia, hypotension, or fatigue.

Bispecific Antibody Therapy

Treatment using an engineered antibody that binds two different targets, such as a cancer-cell marker and an immune-cell marker, to bring cells together or block more than one disease pathway. It is used for selected cancers and can cause immune reactions or other treatment-specific effects.

Bisphenol A

An endocrine-disrupting industrial chemical used predominantly in the synthesis of polycarbonate plastics and epoxy resins lining food and beverage containers. It exhibits weak estrogenic and antiandrogenic activity and has been implicated in metabolic and reproductive disturbances.

Alternate Names:
BPA; 4,4'-(Propane-2,2-diyl)diphenol

Bisphosphonate

A class of antiresorptive medications (e.g., alen-

dronate, risedronate, zoledronic acid) that bind avidly to hydroxyapatite crystals in mineralized bone and inhibit osteoclast-mediated bone resorption, primarily by inhibiting farnesyl pyrophosphate synthase. Indicated for osteoporosis, Paget disease of bone, and hypercalcemia or bone metastases of malignancy, they carry risks of chemical esophagitis (with oral forms), atypical subtrochanteric femur fractures, and osteonecrosis of the jaw (ONJ).

Bisphosphonate-Related Osteonecrosis of the Jaw

An older term for jawbone necrosis associated with current or previous bisphosphonate exposure. The case definition includes exposed jawbone, or bone probeable through a fistula, persisting for more than eight weeks, without prior jaw radiation. Medication-related osteonecrosis is the broader term for cases linked to other antiresorptive or antiangiogenic medicines.

Alternate Names:
BRONJ

Bisphosphonates

Plural form; see *Bisphosphonate*.

Bitemporal Hemianopia

A visual field deficit characterized by the loss of vision in the outer (temporal) halves of both the right and left visual fields. It is classically caused by compression of decussating nasal retinal nerve fibers at the optic chiasm, most commonly by a pituitary adenoma, craniopharyngioma, or optic chiasm glioma.

Bitemporal Hemianopsia

Alternate spelling; see *Bitemporal Hemianopia*.

Bitewing

A dental X-ray showing the crowns of upper and lower teeth and the bone around them in one image. It is especially useful for finding decay between teeth and early loss of supporting bone.

Bitewing Radiograph

An X-ray taken inside the mouth that shows the crowns of back teeth and the nearby gum-supporting bone. It helps detect decay between teeth and bone loss from gum disease.

Bitot's Spots

Foamy, white or grey patches on the white part of the eye, usually near the cornea. They are commonly linked to vitamin A deficiency and may occur with dry eyes or poor night vision. Untreated vitamin A deficiency can damage the eye.

Alternate Names:
Bitot Spots; Conjunctival Foamy Patches; Keratinized Conjunctival Plaques

Bituminosis

A work-related breathing disorder caused by repeated exposure to bitumen or asphalt fumes and dust. It may irritate the airways and contribute to chronic cough, breathlessness, or other lung disease.

Biuret Test

A laboratory test that detects protein by turning violet when protein reacts with a copper-containing solution. It is mainly used in teaching, research, and some chemical analyses rather than routine patient diagnosis.

Bizarre Parosteal Osteochondromatous Proliferation

A rare benign but locally recurrent bone-surface lesion composed of cartilage, bone, and spindle cells; it most often affects the hands or feet.

Alternate Names:
Nora Lesion (less preferred name)

BK Virus

A common virus that usually remains inactive after childhood infection. It can reactivate when immunity is suppressed, especially after organ transplantation, and damage the transplanted kidney or urinary tract.

BK Virus Nephropathy

Kidney inflammation and damage caused by reactivation of BK polyomavirus, usually in a kidney-

transplant recipient. It can impair function of the transplanted kidney and is associated with viral replication in the urinary tract or kidney.

Black Death

The major plague pandemic of the fourteenth century, caused mainly by the bacterium Yersinia pestis. It caused widespread severe illness and death and is distinct from the individual forms of plague seen today.

Black Eye

Bruising and swelling around the eye, usually caused by blunt trauma. Vision may remain normal; eye pain, double vision, reduced vision, an irregular pupil, severe headache, vomiting, or loss of consciousness can indicate an eye or orbital injury.

Alternate Names:
Periorbital Hematoma; Shiner

Black Fly

A small biting fly that can cause painful or itchy skin reactions. In some tropical regions, black flies spread the parasite that causes river blindness.

Black Hairy Tongue

A usually harmless dark, furry appearance of the tongue caused by overgrown surface projections trapping debris or pigment. It may improve with tongue cleaning, good oral hygiene, and addressing smoking or dry mouth.

Blackhead

An open comedo in which a plug of sebum and keratin widens a hair follicle's opening at the skin surface. Exposure to air darkens the plug. Blackheads are noninflammatory acne lesions, not dirt.

Blackheads

Alternate name; see *Blackhead*.

Blackish Urine

Urine that appears very dark brown or black. Causes include blood pigments such as hemoglobin or myoglobin, bilirubin, certain medicines, or homogentisic acid in alkaptonuria. Urine testing can help distinguish these causes. It is a visible sign rather than a diagnosis; the color alone does not show the cause.

Black Lung

Lung disease caused by long-term inhalation of coal dust, usually in miners. It can cause cough and breathlessness and may progress from small areas of dust-related damage to extensive permanent scarring.

Black Lung Disease

A dust-related lung disease caused by prolonged coal-dust exposure. It may cause no symptoms at first but can lead to cough, breathlessness, reduced lung function, and severe permanent scarring.

Black Nightshade Poisoning

Poisoning after eating black nightshade or its berries, which may contain toxic plant chemicals. It can cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, confusion, enlarged pupils, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Black Or Tarry Stools

Black or tarry stools may indicate upper gastrointestinal bleeding, but can also result from iron or bismuth.

Blackout

A period for which a person cannot remember events, often after heavy alcohol use. Memory loss can also occur with drugs, seizures, head injury, fainting, or other causes of altered consciousness.

Alternate Names:
Amnestic Episode; Alcohol-Related Amnesia When Caused by Alcohol

Black Stain

Dark discoloration on the tooth surface, often near the gumline, caused by external deposits or chromogenic bacteria. Dental assessment determines the cause and appropriate removal.

Black Triangle

A triangular gap between neighboring teeth near the gumline, usually caused by loss or shrinkage of the gum papilla after gum disease, injury, or dental treatment. It may trap food and can be treated cosmetically or orthodontically.

Blackwater Fever

A severe complication of malaria in which red blood cells break down inside blood vessels. It can cause dark urine, severe anaemia, jaundice, kidney failure, and shock.

Black Widow Spider

The black widow spider is a venomous spider whose bite can cause severe muscle pain, abdominal cramping, sweating, hypertension, and autonomic symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Black Widow Spider Bite; Latrodectism

Black Widow Spider Bite

Envenomation by a *Latrodectus* spider. It may cause local pain followed by severe muscle cramps, abdominal rigidity, sweating, nausea, hypertension, or other autonomic symptoms.

Bladder

A muscular hollow organ that stores urine from the kidneys and contracts to release it through the urethra during urination.

Bladder Augmentation

Surgery that enlarges the bladder, usually by adding a section of bowel or another tissue. It can increase urine storage when the bladder is too small or has high pressure.

Bladder Biopsy

Removal of a small piece of bladder lining, usually during cystoscopy, for laboratory examination. It can investigate a visible growth, unexplained blood in the urine, inflammation, or suspected bladder cancer.

Bladder Calculi

Alternate name; see *Bladder Stones*.

Bladder Catheterization

The insertion of a sterile, flexible tube (catheter) through the urethra into the urinary bladder to drain urine or instill fluids; see *Urinary Catheterization*.

Bladder Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the urinary bladder, most often from the urothelial lining. Blood in the urine is a common presenting feature, although symptoms vary.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Bladder Neoplasm

Bladder Carcinoma

Cancer that begins in the lining of the urinary bladder, most often in cells called urothelial cells. Blood in the urine is common; smoking and some workplace chemical exposures increase risk.

Bladder Diary

A record of drinks, urination times, urine amounts, urgency, leakage, and nighttime voiding over several days. It helps describe bladder habits and patterns of urinary symptoms.

Bladder Diseases

Disorders of the bladder, including infection, stones, tumors, neurogenic dysfunction, inflammation, obstruction, and impaired emptying.

Bladder Disorders

A broad spectrum of pathological conditions affecting the urinary bladder, encompassing infectious cystitis, interstitial cystitis (bladder pain syndrome), urothelial carcinoma, neurogenic bladder dysfunction, calculi, and bladder outlet obstruction.

Alternate Names:
Bladder Diseases; Urinary Bladder Diseases; Diseases of the Bladder

Bladder Diverticula

Alternate name; see *Bladder Diverticulum*.

Bladder Diverticulum

A pouch that projects outward from the bladder wall. It may be present from birth or develop when urine repeatedly meets resistance as it leaves the bladder. Some diverticula trap urine and are associated with infection, stones, or incomplete emptying.

Bladder Exstrophy

Bladder Exstrophy is a rare birth defect in which the bladder is open and exposed outside the body through a defect in the lower abdominal wall. It is part of the exstrophy–epispadias complex and may also affect the urethra, pelvic bones, pelvic floor, abdominal muscles, and genitals. It can cause difficulty storing urine, urinary leakage, urine-control problems, and risks to the kidneys.

Bladder Exstrophy Repair

Reconstructive surgery for bladder exstrophy that places the bladder inside the body and repairs the lower abdomen and genitals. Treatment is often staged and aims to protect the kidneys and improve urine control.

Bladder Fistula

An abnormal passage between the bladder and another organ or the skin, often the vagina, bowel, or uterus. It may cause constant urine leakage, repeated infection, gas or stool in urine, or unusual vaginal wetness.

Bladder Health And Disorders

Healthy bladder function stores urine and releases it at an appropriate time. Common problems include infection, urgency, leakage, inability to empty, stones, inflammation, and nerve-related bladder dysfunction.

Bladder Infection

An infection of the bladder, usually caused by bacteria. It may cause burning urination, frequent or urgent urination, lower-abdominal discomfort, cloudy or bloody urine, and sometimes fever.

Bladder Infections in Children

Urinary tract infections involving a child's bladder, usually caused by bacteria. Symptoms may include painful urination, frequent urination, new wetting, abdominal or back pain, fever, or vomiting; infants may have only fever or poor feeding.

Bladder Infections in Teens and Adults

Bacterial infection of the bladder, commonly called cystitis. Burning urination, urgency, frequency, lower-abdominal discomfort, or blood in the urine are typical; fever, flank pain, or vomiting may indicate kidney involvement.

Bladder Inflammation

Inflammation of the bladder lining, which may result from infection, irritation, medicines, radiation, or other causes. Interstitial cystitis, also called bladder pain syndrome, is a separate chronic pain condition.

Bladder Neck

The narrow lower part of the bladder where it joins the urethra. Its muscles help control the release of urine and can contribute to blockage if they scar or fail to relax.

Bladder Neck Contracture

Scar-related narrowing of the bladder outlet, often after prostate surgery or other treatment. It can restrict urine flow and cause a weak stream, difficulty emptying, or urinary retention.

Bladder Neck Obstruction

Narrowing or blockage where the bladder joins the urethra, making it difficult for urine to leave the bladder. It may cause a weak stream, straining, incomplete emptying, urinary retention, or recurrent infection.

Bladder Neoplasm

An abnormal growth arising in the bladder. It may be noncancerous or cancerous; diagnosis requires examination, imaging, cystoscopy, and often a tissue sample to determine its type and extent.

Bladder Outlet Obstruction

A blockage where urine leaves the bladder, caused by an enlarged prostate, scarred urethra, stone, tumour, or pelvic-organ prolapse. It may cause a weak stream, difficulty starting, retention, infection, or kidney damage.

Bladder Pain

Pain or pressure felt in the lower abdomen or pelvis that may relate to infection, stones, inflammation, bladder pain syndrome, injury, or cancer. Blood in urine, fever, severe pain, or inability to urinate may accompany serious urinary disease.

Bladder Pain Syndrome

Bladder-related pain, pressure, or discomfort with lower urinary tract symptoms, such as urgency or frequency, lasting more than six weeks without infection or another identifiable cause. Symptoms often flare and settle.

Bladder Perforation

A tear or hole in the bladder wall caused by trauma, pelvic surgery, instrumentation, severe inflammation, or obstruction. Urine may leak into surrounding tissues, causing abdominal pain, distention, blood in the urine, or infection.

Bladder Problems

Conditions that interfere with storing or passing urine, such as leakage, urgency, repeated infection, stones, or inability to empty. Causes include infection, weak pelvic muscles, nerve disease, prostate enlargement, or blockage.

Bladder Prolapse

Alternate name; see *Anterior Vaginal Prolapse*.

Bladder Retraining

A planned urination schedule that gradually increases time between bathroom visits to improve bladder control and reduce urgency.

Bladder Spasm

An involuntary contraction of the bladder muscle that can cause sudden urgency, cramping, urine leakage, or pain. It may occur with infection, catheter use, bladder irritation, neurological conditions, or after surgery.

Bladder Stones

Hard mineral deposits in the bladder that may cause pain, blood in urine, frequent urination, interrupted flow, or difficulty emptying. Some cause no symptoms and are found during tests for another problem.

Bladder Trauma

Injury to the bladder caused by a blow, pelvic fracture, penetrating wound, surgery, or a medical instrument. It may cause blood in the urine, lower-abdominal pain, difficulty urinating, or leakage of urine into nearby tissues.

Blalock-Taussig Operation

A palliative shunt connecting a systemic artery to a pulmonary artery to increase blood flow to the lungs in selected cyanotic congenital heart defects. Modified versions use a small graft between the arteries; the procedure is also called a Blalock-Thomas-Taussig shunt.

Blalock-Taussig Shunt

A palliative surgical procedure designed to augment pulmonary blood flow in infants with cyanotic congenital heart defects characterized by restricted pulmonary flow (such as tetralogy of Fallot or pulmonary atresia). The classic procedure anastomosed the subclavian artery directly to the pulmonary artery, whereas the modified technique uses a synthetic Gore-Tex graft between the subclavian and pulmonary arteries.

Alternate Names:
BT Shunt; Blalock-Thomas-Taussig Shunt

Bland Diet

A temporary eating pattern using soft, mildly seasoned foods and avoiding items that worsen a person's symptoms. It may help some stomach or bowel problems but does not treat their underlying cause.

Blaschko Lines

Invisible patterns formed by the movement of skin cells before birth. Some birthmarks and skin diseases follow these lines as stripes or swirls; they usually do not follow nerves or blood vessels.

BLAST

See *Blast Cell*.

Blast Cell

An early, immature blood cell produced in the bone marrow that normally matures into a functional white blood cell, red blood cell, or platelet. Healthy bone marrow contains only a very small percentage of these cells. A large accumulation of blast cells in the bone marrow or bloodstream prevents normal blood cell development and is a defining characteristic of acute leukemias.

Blast Crisis

An advanced, rapidly worsening phase of some blood cancers in which immature blast cells fill the bone marrow or blood and behave like acute leukaemia.

Blastema

A mass of undifferentiated, highly proliferating embryonic cells capable of growth and cellular differentiation into organs, tissues, or specialized structures; in nephroblastoma (Wilms tumor), blastemal cells constitute a primitive malignant component.

Blastic Plasmacytoid Dendritic-Cell Neoplasm

A rare, fast-growing blood cancer arising from immature immune cells. It often affects the skin, bone marrow, lymph nodes, or nervous system.

Blast Injuries

Plural form; see *Blast Injury*.

Blast Injury

Physical trauma resulting from an explosion, categorized into primary (direct blast shock wave overpressure injuring air-filled organs: pulmonary barotrauma, tympanic membrane perforation, bowel perforation), secondary (penetrating injuries from flying fragments/debris), tertiary (blunt trauma from body displacement against objects), and quaternary (burns, toxic gas inhalation, crush asphyxia).

Blastocyst

An early embryo formed about five to six days after fertilization. It is a hollow group of cells with an inner group that can become the fetus and an outer layer that helps form the placenta.

Blastocystis

A common microscopic organism that may be found in the digestive tract after contaminated food or water is swallowed. Many people have no symptoms, and it is not always clear whether it causes illness. Diarrhoea, stomach cramps, bloating, or nausea may occur. Stool testing can detect it, but a positive result does not prove that it caused the symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Blastocystis Hominis; Blastocystis spp.; Blastocystosis; Intestinal Blastocystis

Blastocystis Hominis

Historical name; see *Blastocystis*.

Blastocystosis

Alternate name; see *Blastocystis*.

Blastocyst Transfer

An assisted-reproduction procedure in which an embryo grown in the laboratory for about five or six days is placed inside the uterus. The decision to transfer one or more embryos considers success rates, patient factors, and the risk of multiple pregnancy.

Blastoma

A cancer that develops from immature or embryonic cells. The specific name identifies the organ and tumour type, such as a kidney, nerve, liver, or eye blastoma.

Blastomyces Dermatitidis

A fungus found in soil and damp organic material that can cause blastomycosis when its spores are

inhaled. Infection usually affects the lungs but can spread to skin, bones, joints, or other organs.

Blastomycosis

A fungal infection caused by *Blastomyces*, usually acquired by inhaling spores from soil. It primarily affects the lungs and can cause pneumonia; disseminated infection may involve the skin, bones and joints, genitourinary system, or central nervous system. It does not spread from person to person.

Blast Phase

An advanced phase of some blood cancers in which many immature blast cells appear in the blood or marrow. The disease becomes more aggressive and may resemble acute leukaemia.

Blasts

Plural form; see *Blast Cell*.

Blautia Producta

A bacterium that normally lives in the human intestine and grows without oxygen. It is usually harmless but has occasionally been found in infections, especially in people with serious illness.

Bleb

A small thin-walled pocket containing air or fluid. In the lung, a bleb can rupture and cause a collapsed lung; on the skin, the term may describe a blister-like lesion.

Bleeder's Disease

Alternate name; see *Hemophilia*.

Bleeding

The escape of blood from blood vessels. It may be visible outside the body or occur inside a tissue, organ, or body cavity; severe, unexplained, or persistent bleeding can indicate significant blood loss or underlying disease.

Bleeding Disorder

A condition causing unusually heavy, prolonged, or spontaneous bleeding because of problems with clotting proteins, platelets, blood vessels, or medicines. Examples include hemophilia, von Willebrand disease, platelet disorders, and some forms of disseminated intravascular coagulation.

Bleeding Disorders

Alternate name; see *Bleeding Disorder*.

Bleeding Esophageal Varices

Severe bleeding from enlarged, fragile veins in the lower swallowing tube. These veins usually develop when liver disease raises pressure in veins entering the liver. Vomiting blood or passing black stools is an emergency.

Bleeding Gums

Bleeding from the gum tissue, often caused by plaque-related gingivitis, periodontitis, trauma, or vigorous brushing. It can also occur with blood disorders or medicines that affect clotting. Persistent bleeding, swelling, loose teeth, or spontaneous bleeding requires dental or medical evaluation.

Bleeding Into A Thyroid Nodule

Alternate name; see *Hemorrhagic Thyroid Nodule*.

Bleeding Tendency

An increased susceptibility to bleeding, which may result from platelet disorders, coagulation factor deficiencies, vascular abnormalities, or anticoagulant medications. Evaluation includes personal and family history, complete blood count, and coagulation studies.

Bleeding Time

An older test measuring how long a small skin puncture takes to stop bleeding. It mainly reflected platelet function and small blood vessels and has largely been replaced by more reliable laboratory tests.

Bleeding Varices

Enlarged fragile veins, usually in the swallowing tube or stomach, that have ruptured and are bleeding. Vomiting blood, black stools, weakness, or

faintness indicates a life-threatening emergency.

Blennorrhea

Thick discharge containing mucus and pus from a moist body surface, especially the urethra or eye. Causes include infection and inflammation, so the affected site and other symptoms guide testing and treatment.

Bleomycin

A cancer medicine that damages tumour-cell DNA and is used for selected cancers. Its most important serious risk is lung injury; fever, skin changes, low blood counts, and allergic reactions can also occur.

Bleomycin Sulfate

The sulphate form of bleomycin, a cancer medicine that damages DNA. A serious potential adverse effect is lung injury, which can be permanent.

Blepharitis

Inflammation of the edges of the eyelids. It can cause redness, itching or burning, crusts at the eyelashes, and watery or dry eyes. It may affect the lash follicles at the front edge or the oil glands inside the eyelid and often comes back.

Alternate Names:
Eyelid Margin Disease

Blepharoconjunctivitis

Inflammation of the eyelid edges and the surface covering the eye. It can cause crusting, itching, redness, tearing, and irritation due to infection, allergy, dry eye, or blocked eyelid glands.

Blepharophimosis

Abnormally short horizontal openings between the eyelids. It may occur with drooping eyelids and other facial or developmental features and can interfere with vision.

Blepharoplasty

Surgery on the upper or lower eyelids that removes, repositions, or reshapes excess skin, muscle, or fat. It may improve eyelid function or appearance; ptosis repair is a related procedure that specifically raises a drooping eyelid.

Blepharoptosis

Drooping of the upper eyelid because of a weak muscle, damaged nerve, stretched tendon, birth difference, ageing, or a heavy eyelid. It can obstruct vision and may signal a neurological emergency if sudden.

Blepharospasm

Involuntary tightening of the muscles around the eyes, causing repeated blinking or forceful eyelid closure. It may occur alone or with eye irritation, medicines, or a movement disorder.

Blind

Having severe or complete loss of vision that substantially limits the ability to see. The cause and remaining level of vision are described because blindness varies in degree and may affect one or both eyes.

Blinded

In a research study, describing a participant, clinician, assessor, or analyst who does not know the assigned treatment or relevant result. This helps reduce expectations from influencing care or measurements.

Blinding

Keeping treatment assignments or study information hidden from selected participants, clinicians, assessors, or analysts to reduce expectation and measurement bias. A study states exactly who is unaware and what is concealed.

Blind Loop Syndrome

Poor absorption caused by excess bacteria growing in a slow-moving or bypassed part of the small intestine. It may cause bloating, diarrhoea, weight loss, and vitamin deficiencies and can follow surgery or bowel disease.

Blindness

Severe or complete loss of vision in one or both eyes caused by disease, injury, or a developmental condition affecting the eye, optic nerve, or brain. Sudden vision loss is an emergency.

Blindness And Vision Loss

Reduced or absent ability to see caused by problems in the eye, optic nerve, brain, injury, or development. It may be sudden or gradual, partial or complete, and temporary or permanent.

Blind Spot

An area within the field of vision where sight is absent. Everyone has a normal small blind spot where the optic nerve leaves the retina, but a new or enlarged blind spot may indicate eye or nerve disease.

Blinking

Repeated brief closing and reopening of the eyelids that spreads tears, protects the cornea, and clears particles. It may increase with irritation, stress, tics, or vision problems and decrease during prolonged screen use.

Blister

A raised pocket of fluid within or beneath the outer layer of skin. Small blisters are called vesicles; larger ones are called bullae. Blisters can result from rubbing, burns, heat, infection, allergy, or inflammatory skin disease and commonly affect the hands and feet.

Alternate Names:
Bulla; Vesicle When Small

Bloating

A feeling of abdominal fullness, tightness, or visible swelling. Gas, constipation, food intolerance, or digestive disorders are common causes; persistent bloating may occur with weight loss, vomiting, pain, or early fullness.

Block

An obstruction or interruption of flow, movement, electrical signals, or communication. The meaning depends on the structure involved, such as an airway, nerve, blood vessel, or heart.

Blockage Of Upper Airway

Obstruction of airflow through the nose, mouth, throat, or voice box. It can rapidly cause suffocation; noisy breathing, inability to speak, blue skin, or severe distress may occur.

Blocked Tear Duct

Obstruction of the nasolacrimal drainage system that prevents tears from draining from the eye into the nasal cavity. It presents with epiphora (persistent tearing), mucoid discharge, and recurrent conjunctivitis or dacryocystitis. In infants, congenital nasolacrimal duct obstruction is commonly due to persistence of a membrane at the valve of Hasner and usually resolves spontaneously.

Blocked Tear Ducts

Plural form; see *Blocked Tear Duct*.

Blocked Ureter

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Obstruction*.

Blocking Agent

A substance that prevents or reduces a biological process by blocking a receptor, channel, enzyme, or other target. Its effects and risks depend on the target and the tissue affected.

Alternate Names:
Blocker; Antagonist When It Acts by Receptor Antagonism

Blocking Agents

Plural form; see *Blocking Agent*.

Blocking Antibody

An immune protein that prevents another molecule from attaching to its target or interferes with a biological interaction. It may be used as treatment, protect against disease, or contribute to an autoimmune disorder.

Blood

A body fluid made of plasma, red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets. It carries oxygen, nutrients, hormones, and waste and helps fight infection, stop bleeding, and regulate temperature.

Blood-Air Barrier

The thin boundary between air in the lung air sacs and blood in nearby capillaries. Oxygen crosses into the blood and carbon dioxide crosses into the air; the barrier is made from the air-sac lining, a thin shared layer, and the capillary lining.

Alternate Names:
Alveolar-Capillary Membrane

Blood Alcohol Concentration

The amount of alcohol in a person's blood, usually expressed as a percentage or mass per volume. Effects depend on the level, timing, tolerance, other substances, and health; one result does not fully predict impairment.

Blood Alcohol Level

A measurement of alcohol concentration in blood. Its effects depend on the amount, timing, tolerance, other substances, and individual health, so a given level may affect people differently.

Blood Alcohol Test

A laboratory assay or breath test that quantifies the concentration of ethanol in the bloodstream; see *Blood Alcohol Concentration*.

Blood Bank

A medical laboratory service that collects, tests, processes, and stores donated blood and blood components. It performs blood-group typing and antibody screening; compatibility testing, including crossmatching when indicated, helps select suitable products for transfusion.

Alternate Names:
Blood Banking; Transfusion Service; Immunohematology Laboratory

Blood Banking

Alternate name; see *Blood Bank*.

Blood Biomarker

A measurable sign of a disease or condition that can be isolated or detected in a blood sample, such as a disease-associated antibody, hormone, protein, or other substance.

Blood Blister

A raised pocket under the skin containing blood, usually caused by rubbing, pinching, pressure, or another injury that breaks small blood vessels.

Blood-Borne Disease

An infection that can spread through infected blood or certain body fluids, for example through shared needles, needlestick injuries, sexual exposure, or contaminated medical equipment. Examples include HIV and hepatitis B and C.

Blood-Borne Pathogens

Alternate spelling; see *Bloodborne Pathogens*.

Bloodborne Pathogens

Infectious agents transmitted through blood or certain body fluids. Examples include HIV and hepatitis B and C viruses. Depending on the pathogen, transmission can occur through contaminated sharps or contact with mucous membranes, sexual contact, or transmission during pregnancy or birth.

Blood Brain Barrier

Alternate spelling; see *Blood-Brain Barrier*.

Blood-Brain Barrier

A highly selective physiological semipermeable border formed by capillary endothelial cells interconnected by continuous tight junctions (claudins, occludin, and junctional adhesion molecules), surrounding pericytes, a basal lamina, and astrocytic perivascular end-feet (glia limitans). It tightly regulates solute and nutrient exchange between the systemic circulation and the central nervous system

parenchyma, maintaining neural microenvironment homeostasis while protecting brain tissue from circulating neurotoxins, pathogens, and biochemical fluctuations.

Blood Cancer

A cancer affecting blood-forming tissue, blood cells, or the lymphatic system. Abnormal cells can crowd out normal cells, impair immunity, cause anaemia or bleeding, or spread to organs.

Blood Cell

A formed element of blood. Red blood cells carry oxygen, white blood cells help fight infection, and platelets—small fragments released by large cells in the bone marrow—help stop bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Hematic Cells

Blood Cholesterol

Cholesterol carried in the blood. The body needs it to build cell membranes and make hormones and bile acids. Too much LDL cholesterol can form fatty buildup in the arteries and increase the risk of heart disease and stroke. Blood cholesterol is usually checked as part of a lipid profile.

Blood Cholinesterase Test

A laboratory test measuring cholinesterase enzyme activity in red blood cells or plasma. It can help assess exposure to certain insecticides and identify an inherited enzyme deficiency that affects how the body breaks down some medicines.

Alternate Names:
Pseudocholinesterase Test; Plasma Cholinesterase; Serum Butyrylcholinesterase

Blood Chromium Test

A specialized trace element assay quantifying whole blood or serum chromium concentrations to assess occupational exposure, evaluate metal-on-metal orthopedic implant wear and systemic metallosis, or monitor trace element balance in total parenteral nutrition.

Alternate Names:
Serum Chromium; Whole Blood Chromium; Chromium Exposure Test

Blood Circulation

The continuous movement of blood from the heart through the lungs and body and back again. It delivers oxygen and nutrients and carries away carbon dioxide and other waste.

Blood Clot

A gelatinous mass formed by aggregated platelets and cross-linked fibrin mesh during the coagulation cascade, serving physiologically to achieve hemostasis following vascular injury. Pathological intravascular formation (thrombosis) can occlude arterial or venous lumen, causing myocardial infarction, ischemic stroke, deep vein thrombosis, or pulmonary embolism.

Alternate Names:
Thrombus

Blood Clot in Lung

Alternate name; see *Pulmonary Embolism*.

Blood Clots

Plural form; see *Blood Clot*.

Blood Coagulation

The linked process that changes blood from a liquid to a firm clot after injury. Too little clotting causes bleeding, while excessive or misplaced clotting can cause dangerous vessel blockage.

Blood Coagulation Disorder

A condition in which blood clots too little, too much, or at the wrong time. Bleeding disorders result from inadequate clot formation, whereas thrombophilic disorders cause excessive or misplaced clotting. Causes include genetic variants, medicines, liver disease, immune conditions, cancer, and other illness. Examples include hemophilia, von Willebrand disease, thrombocytopenia, thrombophilia, and disseminated intravascular coagulation.

Blood Component Pathogen Reduction

A process used to reduce certain infectious agents in

donated blood components. It may use ultraviolet or visible light, sometimes with an added chemical, but does not eliminate every infectious risk.

Blood Count

A blood test measuring the number and features of red cells, white cells, and platelets. It helps assess anaemia, infection, inflammation, bleeding risk, and disorders of the bone marrow.

Blood Culture

A test in which blood is placed in special bottles to see whether bacteria or fungi grow. It helps investigate bloodstream infection, sepsis, or infection of the heart valves.

Blood Culture Contamination

Accidental entry of skin or environmental organisms into a blood-culture bottle during collection or handling, rather than true infection in the blood. It can lead to unnecessary antibiotics, so results are interpreted with symptoms and other culture sets.

Blood Differential Test

A blood test measuring the numbers and proportions of different white blood cells, including neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils. It can help investigate infection, inflammation, allergy, leukaemia, or marrow disease.

Blood Donation

Voluntary collection of whole blood or selected blood components from a screened donor for transfusion or manufacture of medical products. Eligibility checks, infection testing, sterile collection, and post-donation recovery protect donor and recipient.

Blood Donation Before Surgery

Collection and storage of a person's own blood before an operation for possible later transfusion. It can cause anaemia, and the stored blood may go unused if the operation is postponed or cancelled.

Blood Donor

A person who gives blood or blood components for transfusion or medical use. Screening protects the donor and helps ensure that donated blood is safe for the recipient.

Blood Draw

Collection of blood, usually with a needle placed in a vein, for testing, donation, or treatment. Temporary pain, bruising, dizziness, or rarely infection may occur.

Blood Dyscrasia

A broad, nonspecific term for a disorder of blood cells, platelets, or clotting components. It does not identify which component is affected or the cause; more specific terms include anemia, leukopenia, and thrombocytopenia.

Blood Film

A thin layer of peripheral blood spread onto a glass microscope slide, stained with a Romanowsky stain (e.g., Wright-Giemsa), and examined under microscopy for quantitative and qualitative evaluation of erythrocyte morphology, leukocyte differentials, platelet adequacy, and identification of bloodborne parasites.

Alternate Names:
Peripheral Blood Smear; Blood Smear; Peripheral Smear

Blood Flow

The movement of blood through vessels and organs. It depends mainly on the pressure difference and resistance in the vessels and delivers oxygen and nutrients while removing waste.

Blood Flow Velocity

The speed at which blood moves through a vessel. It is usually fastest in large arteries and slowest in capillary networks, allowing time for exchange with tissues.

Blood Gas Analysis

A test measuring blood pH, oxygen, carbon dioxide, and often bicarbonate. It helps assess ventilation, oxygenation, and acid–base balance.

Blood Gases

Measurements of oxygen, carbon dioxide, acidity, and related substances in blood. They help determine how well a person is breathing, exchanging gases, and maintaining acid-base balance.

Blood Glucose

The amount of sugar called glucose in the blood. The body regulates it using food absorption, liver production, insulin, and other hormones; levels that are too low or high can cause illness.

Blood Glucose Monitoring

Measuring glucose in the blood or in fluid just under the skin. A meter gives a reading from a blood sample, while a continuous monitor tracks glucose throughout the day. Monitoring helps people with diabetes and their clinicians follow glucose levels over time.

Alternate Names:
Blood Sugar Monitoring

Blood Glucose Monitors

Portable devices that measure capillary blood glucose, usually with a lancet, test strip, and meter. Readings can be affected by sampling technique, circulation, or device limitations.

Blood Glucose Test

A diagnostic test measuring the concentration of glucose circulating in the blood, essential for diagnosing and managing diabetes mellitus and hypoglycemia; see *Blood Glucose*.

Blood Group

A classification of blood based on markers on red cells. The ABO and Rh systems are used for routine blood matching, although other blood-group systems can also matter. Matching helps reduce harmful reactions during transfusion and pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Blood Type; Blood Groups; ABO and Rh Grouping; Blood Typing

Blood Group Incompatibility

An immune mismatch between donor and recipient blood or between maternal and fetal blood. Antibodies can destroy red blood cells, causing a transfusion reaction or hemolytic disease of the fetus and newborn; the risk depends on the blood-group system and antibody.

Blood Groups

Alternate name; see *Blood Group*.

Blood Group Test

A laboratory test identifying an individual's ABO blood type and Rh antigen status on red blood cells, crucial prior to blood transfusions and during pregnancy; see *Blood Group*.

Blood In Semen

Blood in the fluid released during ejaculation. It is often temporary and may follow infection, inflammation, injury, or a urinary-tract procedure. Persistent or recurrent blood may occur with pain, fever, or urinary symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Hematospermia; Hemospermia

Blood in Stool

Blood passed in or with stool, which may appear bright red, dark red, or black depending on its source. Causes range from haemorrhoids to bowel inflammation, ulcers, or cancer; the appearance alone does not identify the cause.

Blood In The Eye

Bleeding on the eye surface or inside the eye. A small surface bleed may be harmless, while bleeding inside the eye, eye pain, injury, or vision change can indicate significant eye damage.

Blood in Urine

The abnormal presence of red blood cells in the urine, known medically as hematuria. It may be visible to the naked eye (making urine look pink, red, or brownish) or detected only under a microscope during a routine urine test. Common causes

include urinary tract infections, kidney stones, vigorous exercise, prostate enlargement, or conditions affecting the kidneys or bladder.

Alternate Names:
Hematuria; Blood in the Urine

Blood Lancet

Alternate name; see *Lancet*.

Blood Lead Level Test

A quantitative diagnostic laboratory assay measuring venous or capillary whole-blood lead concentration in micrograms per deciliter (μg/dL). Utilized for pediatric screening, occupational exposure monitoring, and evaluating symptomatic plumbism.

Alternate Names:
BLL Assay; Venous Blood Lead Screen; Plumbism Blood Test

Blood Loss

Loss of blood from the circulation because of injury, surgery, childbirth, internal bleeding, or disease. Severe loss can reduce oxygen delivery and cause shock.

Blood Low Red Cell Count

Alternate name; see *Anemia*.

Blood PH

A measure of how acidic or alkaline the blood is. The lungs regulate carbon dioxide and the kidneys regulate acids and bicarbonate; normal arterial pH is about 7.35–7.45.

Blood Plasma

The liquid part of blood, made mostly of water and containing proteins, salts, nutrients, hormones, gases, and waste products. It carries blood cells and dissolved substances throughout the body.

Blood Preservation

The controlled collection, processing, cooling, freezing, and storage of donated blood or its components so they remain safe and effective until transfusion.

Blood Pressure

The force of circulating blood against artery walls, recorded as two numbers in millimetres of mercury. The systolic number is the pressure when the heart contracts; the diastolic number is the pressure between beats.

Blood Pressure Cuff

The inflatable part of a blood-pressure device that wraps around an arm or another limb and briefly compresses an artery. Correct sizing improves measurement accuracy.

Blood Pressure Measurement

Measurement of arterial pressure, usually with an inflatable cuff. The result records systolic pressure during heart contraction and diastolic pressure between contractions; cuff size and positioning affect accuracy.

Blood Pressure Monitor

A device that measures arterial blood pressure, usually with an inflatable cuff and an electronic or manual pressure-reading system. It may be used in clinical settings or at home to record systolic and diastolic pressure, and some devices also detect pulse rate or irregular rhythms.

Blood Pressure Monitors For Home

Devices used to measure blood pressure outside a clinic, usually with an inflatable upper-arm cuff. Readings can vary with the device, cuff fit, body position, and measurement conditions.

Blood Pressure Regulation

The body's control of blood pressure through the heart, blood vessels, kidneys, hormones, and nervous system. These systems adjust heart pumping, blood-vessel width, and body-fluid balance.

Blood Product

A component made from donated blood for medical treatment, such as red blood cells, platelets, plasma, or cryoprecipitate. The product is selected according to the person's bleeding, anaemia, or clotting problem.

Blood Products

Plural form; see *Blood Product*.

Blood Protein

A protein dissolved in blood plasma. These proteins help transport substances, maintain fluid balance, support immunity, and control clotting; abnormal amounts can occur with inflammation, liver or kidney disease, immune disorders, or some cancers.

Blood Results

Values reported from laboratory tests on a blood sample, such as blood-cell counts, glucose, salts, hormones, or liver and kidney markers. Each value is compared with a reference interval for that test; an out-of-range result does not by itself diagnose a disease.

Blood-Retinal Barrier

A selective barrier between blood and the retina, formed by tight junctions in retinal blood vessels and the retinal pigment layer. It controls which substances enter the retina and helps maintain its stable environment.

Alternate Names:
BRB

Blood Sedimentation

The settling of red blood cells in a tube of treated blood. The erythrocyte sedimentation rate is a nonspecific sign that may rise with inflammation, infection, anaemia, pregnancy, or other conditions.

Blood Smear

A thin layer of blood spread on a glass slide, stained, and examined under a microscope. It shows the size, shape, and appearance of blood cells and can reveal abnormal cells, parasites, or cell fragments.

Blood Spatter Analysis

Forensic analysis of bloodstain patterns to help reconstruct events. It may examine stain shape, distribution, and transfer, but conclusions are limited and considered with other evidence.

Bloodstream Infection

An infection involving microorganisms in the bloodstream, usually identified by blood culture. It may arise there or spread from a localized infection or infected intravascular device. Bacteremia means bacteria are present in blood; bacteremia can be transient. Sepsis is life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated response to infection.

Alternate Names:
Bloodstream Infections; BSI

Blood Substitutes

Fluids or artificial products intended to replace some functions of blood. Most restore circulating volume; some are designed to carry oxygen. None replaces every function of blood.

Blood Sugar

The amount of glucose in the blood. Insulin, glucagon, the liver, food, activity, illness, and other hormones affect it. Persistently high or very low levels can cause symptoms and serious organ injury.

Blood Sugar Test

A test measuring glucose in the blood. It may be done while fasting, at a random time, or after a glucose drink, and helps diagnose or monitor diabetes and other disorders of glucose control.

Blood Test

Analysis of blood cells or substances dissolved in blood, including chemicals, proteins, hormones, antibodies, or genetic material. Results help investigate symptoms, diagnose disease, assess organ function, and monitor treatment.

Blood-Testis Barrier

A barrier formed by tight connections between supporting Sertoli cells in the sperm-producing tubules. It separates developing sperm cells from the blood and immune system and helps maintain the conditions needed for sperm development.

Alternate Names:
BTB

Blood Thinner

A common name for medicines that lower the chance of harmful blood clots forming or growing. The term includes anticoagulants, which slow the body's clotting process, and antiplatelet medicines, which make platelets less likely to clump together. They do not literally thin the blood or usually dissolve an existing clot, and they can cause serious bleeding.

Blood Transfusion

The administration of whole blood or a specific blood component, such as red blood cells, platelets, plasma, or cryoprecipitate, to treat blood loss, anaemia, thrombocytopenia, or a clotting-factor deficiency. Red cells improve oxygen-carrying capacity; platelets, plasma, and cryoprecipitate support haemostasis. ABO/Rh typing, antibody screening, and compatibility testing help reduce transfusion reactions. Risks include febrile or allergic reactions, acute haemolysis, circulatory overload, and rare transfusion-transmitted infection; the decision depends on the patient's symptoms, laboratory results, bleeding, and overall clinical context.

Blood Typing

A laboratory test identifying markers on red blood cells, especially the ABO and Rh systems. It helps select compatible blood for transfusion and identifies some pregnancy-related risks from blood-group incompatibility.

Blood Urea Nitrogen

The amount of nitrogen from urea in the blood. Urea is made when the body breaks down protein and is removed mainly by the kidneys; the result is interpreted with creatinine, hydration, and the clinical situation.

Blood Urea Nitrogen Test

A clinical serum chemistry test measuring the amount of nitrogen derived from urea, the principal end product of protein catabolism formed in the liver. Elevated serum concentrations (azotemia) occur in acute or chronic renal impairment, prerenal hypoperfusion, severe dehydration, and upper gastrointestinal hemorrhage.

Alternate Names:
BUN Test; Serum Blood Urea Nitrogen; Urea Nitrogen Test

Blood Vessel

A tubular component of the circulatory system that transports blood throughout the body, comprising arteries, arterioles, capillaries, venules, and veins. Structurally, muscular and elastic vessels consist of three concentric tunics: the tunica intima (endothelial lining), tunica media (vascular smooth muscle and elastin fibers regulating vascular tone and resistance), and tunica adventitia (connective tissue supporting autonomic nerves and vasa vasorum).

Blood Vessels

Plural form; see *Blood Vessel*.

Blood Viscosity

How thick blood is and how much it resists flowing. It is influenced mainly by the number of red blood cells, but also by blood proteins and temperature. Excessively thick blood can slow circulation and increase clot risk.

Blood Volume

The total amount of blood circulating in the body, including plasma and blood cells. Too little can cause low blood pressure and shock; too much can strain the heart and lungs.

Bloom Syndrome

A rare autosomal-recessive disorder caused by pathogenic changes in both copies of the *BLM* gene, which encodes a DNA helicase. It causes marked short stature, a sun-sensitive telangiectatic facial rash, recurrent infections, and a greatly increased risk of multiple cancers, often at unusually young ages.

Blount Disease

A growth disorder in which the upper part of the shinbone grows unevenly, causing worsening bowing of one or both legs. It can affect young children or adolescents and may cause an abnormal gait, unequal leg length, or knee damage.

Blue Baby

An infant whose skin, lips, or nail beds look blue because the blood carries too little oxygen or circulation is reduced. This can occur with heart, lung, airway, or blood disorders.

Alternate Names:
Blue Babies

Blue Bottle

A common name for a bluebottle jellyfish. Its tentacles can inject venom that causes immediate stinging pain, raised marks, redness, and sometimes muscle cramps, breathing difficulty, or a severe allergic reaction.

Blue Discoloration Of The Skin

A blue or gray tint of the skin, lips, or nail beds caused by low oxygen, reduced blood flow, or abnormal haemoglobin. Sudden or widespread discoloration, especially with breathing difficulty or confusion, is an emergency.

Blue Finger/Toes

Alternate name; see *Peripheral Cyanosis*.

Blue-Green Algae

Blue-green algae are cyanobacteria that can grow rapidly in water. Some release toxins that cause skin irritation, vomiting, liver injury, breathing problems, or neurologic illness when people or animals are exposed.

Blue Nevi

Alternate plural name; see *Blue Nevus*.

Blue Nevus

A usually benign blue, blue-gray, or blue-black mole caused by pigment-producing cells deep in the skin. Most remain small and stable. A cellular blue nevus may be larger and, rarely, become cancerous.

Blue Nightshade Poisoning

Illness caused by eating blue nightshade or a related poisonous plant containing glycoalkaloids. Symptoms may include vomiting, diarrhoea, abdominal pain, confusion, weakness, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythm; severe poisoning can be life-threatening.

Blue NæVus

Alternate spelling; see *Blue Nevus*.

Blue Rubber Bleb Nevus Syndrome

A rare disorder with multiple slow-flow venous malformations, typically soft blue or purple compressible skin nodules and lesions in the gastrointestinal tract. Gastrointestinal bleeding can cause iron-deficiency anaemia, and other organs may be involved; evaluation may include imaging, endoscopy, and blood counts.

Blue Sclera

A blue-gray tint in the white part of the eye. It often happens when this layer is thinner than usual, so darker tissue underneath shows through. It can be linked to inherited conditions such as osteogenesis imperfecta, which makes bones break easily.

Blue Sclerae

Alternate plural name; see *Blue Sclera*.

Blue Toe Syndrome

The acute onset of localized cyanosis, purplish discoloration, and painful ischemia of one or more toes in the presence of intact distal pulses, caused by microembolization of atheromatous debris or small cholesterol crystals from proximal arterial sources.

Alternate Names:
Trash Foot; Digital Atheroembolism

Blumberg Sign

Rebound tenderness: abdominal pain that worsens when pressure on the abdomen is suddenly released. It can indicate irritation of the peritoneum but is not specific to one disease.

Blunt Abdominal Trauma

An injury to the abdomen without an object piercing the skin, often caused by a crash, fall, or blow. It can damage the spleen, liver, kidneys, bowel, or

pancreas, sometimes without early visible bruising.

Blunted Affect

Reduced outward expression of emotion. A person may show less facial movement, voice variation, or body language than expected, although their internal feelings may be stronger. It can occur in mental or neurologic disorders.

Blunt Force Trauma

Injury caused by a blow from a blunt object or by striking a blunt surface, without penetration by a sharp edge. It can produce bruises, grazes, torn skin, internal bleeding, fractures, or organ damage.

Blurred Vision

Vision that appears out of focus, hazy, or unclear. Causes include an incorrect glasses prescription, dry eye, eye disease, medicines, migraine, or neurologic illness. Sudden blurring with pain, weakness, or vision loss can occur with serious eye or neurologic disease.

Blush

Alternate name; see *Blushing*.

Blushing

Temporary redness or warmth of the face caused by increased blood flow in the skin. Common triggers include emotion, heat, exercise, alcohol, hormonal changes, medicines, fever, and some illnesses.

B Lymphocyte

Alternate name; see *B Cell*.

B-Lymphocyte

Alternate spelling; see *B Cell*.

B-Lynch Suture

A surgical stitch placed around the uterus to control severe bleeding after childbirth when the uterus remains relaxed and medicines have not stopped the bleeding. It compresses the uterus while usually preserving the possibility of future pregnancy.

B-Mode Ultrasound

The usual two-dimensional ultrasound image created from echoes of sound waves sent into the body. It shows the size, shape, and structure of organs and soft tissues without using radiation.

Board-Like Rigidity

Severe involuntary tightening of the abdominal muscles, making the abdomen feel hard. It can indicate irritation of the abdominal lining from serious inflammation, infection, bleeding, or perforation.

Boas' Sign

Pain or unusual skin sensitivity below the right shoulder blade, traditionally associated with gallbladder disease. It is not specific enough to establish a diagnosis on its own.

Bobble-Head Doll Syndrome

A rare childhood movement disorder causing repeated forward-and-back head movements, often associated with a fluid-filled cyst or another lesion near the third ventricle of the brain.

Bocavirus

A group of small viruses that can infect humans and animals. Human bocavirus most often affects the airways of young children, although infection may cause illness in other tissues or people with weakened immunity.

Bocavirus Infection

A viral infection, usually of the airways in young children. It may cause a runny nose, cough, fever, wheezing, bronchiolitis, or pneumonia, often together with another infection. Breathing difficulty or dehydration can occur in more severe illness.

Bochdalek Hernia

A birth defect in which abdominal organs move through an opening in the back and side of the diaphragm into the chest. It can prevent normal lung development and cause severe breathing problems in a newborn.

Bock's Disease

Older name; see *Sarcoidosis*.

BODE Index

A scoring tool for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease that combines body weight, breathing-test results, breathlessness, and walking distance. A higher score suggests more severe disease and a greater risk of hospital admission or death; it does not predict an individual outcome with certainty.

Alternate Names:
BODE Score; COPD Multidimensional Index

Bodily Secretion

A substance made and released by cells or glands, such as sweat, saliva, mucus, tears, digestive juices, or hormones. Secretions protect tissues, aid digestion, regulate body functions, or help remove waste.

Body Aches

Widespread muscle or body pain that can occur with infection, fever, exercise, inflammation, medicines, or other illness. Severe pain may occur with weakness, dark urine, breathing difficulty, chest pain, or high fever in serious illness.

Body Cavity

An enclosed space inside the body that contains and protects organs. Major cavities include the skull, spinal canal, chest, abdomen, and pelvis; their linings may produce small amounts of lubricating fluid.

Body Cell Mass

The living, metabolically active cells of the body, including cells in muscles, organs, blood, and other tissues. It excludes stored fat and water outside cells and is sometimes estimated in nutrition assessment.

Body Composition

The relative amounts of fat, muscle and other lean tissue, bone mineral, and water in the body. It provides more information about health and nutrition than body weight alone, although estimates vary by method.

Body Dysmorphia

Alternate name; see *Body Dysmorphic Disorder*.

Body Dysmorphic Disorder

A disorder involving persistent preoccupation with one or more perceived appearance flaws that are not observable or appear slight to others. The preoccupation is accompanied by repetitive behaviors or mental acts, such as checking, grooming, comparing, or seeking reassurance, and causes significant distress or impairment.

Alternate Names:
BDD

Body Fat

Adipose tissue that stores energy, cushions organs, insulates the body, and releases hormones and other signals. Too much or too little body fat can affect metabolism, movement, fertility, immunity, and other aspects of health.

Body Fluid

Water and dissolved substances inside and around the body's cells. Body fluid includes fluid inside cells and fluid outside them, such as blood plasma and the fluid between tissues. It carries nutrients and waste and helps regulate body temperature.

Alternate Names:
Bodily Fluids

Body Fluid Exposures

Occupational or accidental contact with blood or potentially infectious body fluids through the eyes, mouth, broken skin, or a penetrating injury. The possibility of infection depends on the fluid, route, and source.

Body Fluids

Alternate name; see *Body Fluid*.

Body Habitus

A person's general build, including body size, shape, muscle, fat distribution, and proportions. Clinicians may record it during an examination, but it does not by itself diagnose disease or predict health.

Body Height

The vertical distance from the soles of the feet to the top of the head, measured while standing when possible. It helps assess growth and nutrition and is used in medication, kidney-function, and other calculations.

Body Identification

The process of establishing who a deceased person is. It may use fingerprints, dental records, medical information, DNA, personal effects, or visual recognition, with the method chosen according to the circumstances.

Body Image

A person's thoughts, feelings, and beliefs about their body and appearance. Distress or inaccurate beliefs about appearance can occur in body dysmorphic disorder, eating disorders, depression, or other mental-health conditions.

Body Lice

Infestation with human body lice, which live mainly in clothing and move to the skin to feed. Bites can cause intense itching, and infestation is associated with clothing and bedding.

Alternate Names:
Pediculosis Corporis; Body Louse Infestation

Body Mass Index

A screening measure calculated by dividing weight in kilograms by height in meters squared. It helps assess weight in relation to height, but it does not directly measure body fat or provide a complete assessment of health. Results are interpreted with age and other clinical factors; children and teens are assessed using age- and sex-specific percentiles.

Alternate Names:
BMI; Quetelet Index; BMI Calculation

Body Odor

Smell produced when skin secretions, especially sweat, are broken down by skin microorganisms. A sudden or unusual change may be related to diet, medicines, infection, or a metabolic disorder.

Body Odor and Sweating

Alternate index label; see *Sweating And Body Odor*.

Body Odour

Smell from the breakdown of skin secretions by microorganisms. The smell can change with sweating, hygiene, diet, medicines, infection, or some metabolic diseases.

Body Of The Epididymis

The middle part of the epididymis, where sperm continue to mature as they move from the head toward the tail.

Body Of The Sternum

The broad middle part of the breastbone between the manubrium and xiphoid process. It joins most of the ribs through their costal cartilages.

Body Piercing

Creation of an opening through skin or a mucous membrane to insert jewellery. Possible complications include pain, bleeding, infection, scarring, allergic reaction, and damage to teeth, nerves, or cartilage.

Body Plethysmography

A breathing test performed inside a sealed cabin to measure lung volumes, including air that cannot be exhaled. It helps identify restricted lungs, overexpanded lungs, and some airway problems.

Body Position

The arrangement of the body or a body part, such as standing, lying on the back, lying face down, or lying on the side. Position can affect breathing, circulation, examination results, and medical procedures.

Body Region

A named area of the body used to describe the location of an organ, symptom, injury, or examination finding, such as the chest, abdomen, pelvis, or arm.

Body Ringworm

A fungal infection of the skin on the body, usually causing an expanding, ring-shaped, scaly rash with a more active edge and clearer centre. It can spread through direct contact or contaminated objects.

Alternate Names:
Tinea Corporis; Dermatophytosis of Glabrous Skin

Body Space

A normal or potential compartment inside the body, such as the space around the lungs or abdominal organs. Air, blood, fluid, or infection can collect there and interfere with organ function.

Body Substance

Material produced by or found in the body, including blood, saliva, urine, faeces, mucus, tissue, and other secretions. Some substances can carry infection and require appropriate handling precautions.

Body Surface

The outside of the body, mainly the skin and accessible mucous membranes. Clinicians may estimate its area when assessing burns, calculating some medicine doses, or making physiological measurements.

Body Surface Area

An estimate of the body's external area, usually calculated from height and weight. It is used in burn assessment, some medicine doses, and selected medical calculations; it is an estimate rather than a direct measurement.

Body Temperature

A measure of the body's thermal state, reflecting the balance between heat production and heat loss. The average normal oral temperature is approximately 37°C (98.6°F), although healthy individuals exhibit a range, typically around 36.1–37.2°C (97–99°F). Body temperature varies with age, circadian rhythm, physical activity, hormonal changes, environmental conditions, and illness. It can be measured orally, rectally, axillary, tympanically (ear), temporally (forehead), or oesophageally. Readings differ by site: rectal temperatures are generally higher and axillary temperatures generally lower than oral measurements. The measurement site and method should be documented for accurate clinical interpretation.

Body Temperature Norms

Expected temperature ranges vary with age, time of day, activity, illness, and whether temperature is measured by mouth, ear, armpit, skin, or rectum. The measurement method and symptoms are considered when interpreting fever or low temperature.

Body Wall

The layers of skin, connective tissue, muscle, and sometimes bone that surround and protect a body compartment, such as the chest or abdomen. They also help movement, breathing, and support.

Body Weight

The measured mass of a person, including fat, muscle, bone, water, and organs. It helps assess growth, nutrition, and fluid changes and is used with other information for some medical calculations.

Boeck's Sarcoid

Older name; see *Sarcoidosis*.

Boerhaave's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Boerhaave Syndrome*.

Boerhaave Syndrome

A spontaneous, full-thickness rupture of the esophageal wall caused by a sudden rise in pressure, most often during forceful vomiting or retching, although vomiting may be absent. Unlike a Mallory–Weiss tear, which affects only the lining, this rupture can let esophageal contents leak into the mediastinum or pleural space, causing severe infection, sepsis, or shock.

Alternate Names:
Boerhaave's Syndrome; Boerhaave's Syndrome

Bogros' Space

A layer of tissue behind the groin region and in front of the abdominal lining. Surgeons use this natural

plane when repairing some groin hernias.

Bohn Nodules

Small, harmless cysts containing keratin that appear on a newborn's gums or the roof of the mouth. They usually disappear without treatment and do not interfere with feeding.

Bohr Effect

The tendency of haemoglobin to release more oxygen when tissues become more acidic or contain more carbon dioxide. This helps active tissues receive oxygen where energy use and carbon-dioxide production are greatest.

Bohring Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder associated with severe developmental delay, poor growth before birth, distinctive facial features, reduced movement, and frequent feeding or breathing difficulties.

Boil

A painful, pus-filled skin abscess centered on an infected hair follicle and surrounding tissue, most commonly caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* bacteria. It typically begins as a tender, red nodule that progressively enlarges, develops a central yellowish head of pus, and eventually ruptures to drain. Multiple or recurrent boils are termed furunculosis, whereas a deeper, connected cluster of several boils is classified as a *Carbuncle*.

Alternate Names:
Furuncle

Boils

Alternate name; see *Boil*.

Boils and Carbuncles

Alternate name; see *Boil* and *Carbuncle*.

Bolt Device

A threaded fastener used in some orthopedic fixation systems to stabilize bone fragments or connect parts of an external fixator. Its design and use depend on the specific fixation system.

Bolus

A single measured amount of medicine or fluid given over a short time, usually by injection or infusion. In digestion, it means food that has been chewed and is ready to swallow.

Bolus Gastrostomy Feeding

Delivery of a measured amount of liquid nutrition or fluid into the stomach through a gastrostomy tube over a short period, often by syringe or gravity. It is a form of enteral feeding.

Alternate Names:
Bolus G-Tube Feeding; G-Tube Bolus Feeding; Bolus Enteral Nutrition; Enteral Bolus Nutrition; Syringe Feeding

Bolus Infusion

Delivery of a measured amount of fluid or medicine into a vein over a short period. The dose and speed depend on the medicine, the person's condition, and the intended effect; errors can cause serious harm.

Bombay Blood Group

A rare inherited blood type in which red blood cells lack the H marker needed to form A or B markers. It may look like type O but is usually compatible only with blood from another Bombay-type donor.

Bombesin Receptor

A protein on or inside a cell that binds bombesin-like signalling substances and changes cell activity. These receptors help regulate processes such as hormone release, digestion, and cell growth and are studied in some cancers.

Bone

A strong living tissue that forms the skeleton, supports the body, protects organs, enables movement with muscles, stores minerals, and contains marrow that makes blood cells. Bone is continually broken down and rebuilt.

Bone-Anchored Hearing Implant

A hearing device fixed to the skull bone that transmits sound vibrations to the inner ear, bypassing

the outer or middle ear. It may be used for selected conductive, mixed, or single-sided hearing loss.

Bone And Mineral Disorders

Diseases affecting bone strength, bone formation, or the body's balance of calcium and phosphate. Examples include osteoporosis, rickets, osteomalacia, parathyroid disorders, and inherited bone diseases.

Bone Callus

New tissue that forms around a broken bone during healing. It first consists of a soft blood clot and connective tissue, then cartilage and immature bone, which are gradually reshaped into stronger bone.

Bone Cancer

Cancer that starts in bone, such as osteosarcoma or chondrosarcoma, or cancer that has spread there from another organ. Persistent focal pain, swelling, or a fracture after minor injury may occur; diagnosis uses imaging and tissue testing.

Bone Cement

A self-curing acrylic biomaterial composed of polymethylmethacrylate (PMMA) utilized in orthopedic and spine surgery to anchor prosthetic joint components, fill osseous voids, and stabilize vertebral compression fractures during vertebroplasty or kyphoplasty.

Alternate Names:
Polymethylmethacrylate; PMMA; Acrylic Bone Cement

Bone Conduction

Hearing sound through vibrations carried by the skull to the inner ear, bypassing the outer and middle ear. Bone-conduction testing helps identify whether hearing loss comes from the outer or middle ear or from the inner ear and nerve.

Bone Cyst

A fluid-filled or blood-filled space within bone. Many bone cysts are benign, but they can weaken the bone and cause pain, swelling, or fracture. Common types include simple bone cysts and aneurysmal bone cysts.

Alternate Names:
Bone Cysts

Bone Densitometry

See *Bone Mineral Density Test*.

Bone Density

The amount of mineral packed into a measured area of bone. It is usually estimated with a DXA scan; lower density is associated with greater fracture risk, while age and other risk factors affect interpretation.

Bone Density Scan

A noninvasive radiological scan measuring bone mineral content per volume to detect osteopenia and osteoporosis and evaluate fracture risk; see *Bone Densitometry* and *Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry*.

Bone Density Screening

A DXA scan that measures bone mineral at sites such as the hip and spine. It helps identify osteoporosis and estimate fracture risk, especially in people with age-related or other risk factors.

Bone Development

The formation, growth, and shaping of bones from before birth through adulthood. Bones lengthen and widen as new tissue is made and old tissue is removed; hormones, nutrition, activity, and injury influence this process.

Bone Disease

Any condition that weakens, deforms, inflames, infects, or otherwise damages bone. Examples include osteoporosis, fractures, infections, tumours, inherited skeletal disorders, and diseases caused by abnormal mineral or hormone levels.

Bone Dysplasia

A disorder of bone formation or growth that gives one or more bones an unusual size, shape, or strength. Some bone dysplasias are inherited, while others arise during development for different reasons. Effects vary and may include short stature,

deformity, or bones that break easily.

Bone Fracture

A partial or complete break in a bone caused by injury, repeated stress, or weakened bone. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, and loss of function may occur. An open fracture or associated nerve or blood- vessel injury is a serious complication.

Bone Fractures

Alternate name; see *Bone Fracture*.

Bone Graft

Bone tissue or a substitute placed in a bone defect to support repair, join bones together, rebuild an area, or help a fracture heal. The material may come from the person, a donor, or a synthetic source.

Bone Grafting

A surgical procedure that transplants bone tissue—either from the patient, a donor, or a synthetic matrix—to repair, stabilize, or promote healing of fractured or diseased bone; see *Bone Graft*.

Bone Health

The strength, structure, and ability of bones to grow, repair, and resist fractures. It is influenced by age, nutrition, hormones, physical activity, medicines, smoking, alcohol, and medical conditions.

Bone Infarction

Death of bone and bone-marrow tissue caused by loss of blood supply. The term often refers to an affected area in the middle or shaft of a long bone; it is related to osteonecrosis, which can occur in different parts of bone. Some bone infarcts cause no symptoms and are found on imaging done for another reason.

Alternate Names:
Bone Infarct

Bone Infection

Infection of bone, usually caused by bacteria. It may reach bone through the bloodstream, spread from nearby tissue, or enter through surgery or an open injury, causing pain, swelling, fever, or poor healing.

Bone Lesion Biopsy

Removal of a small sample from an abnormal area of bone with a needle or operation for laboratory examination. Testing can distinguish infection, noncancerous growth, and cancer; the biopsy route can affect later surgical planning.

Bone Markers in Osteoporosis

Blood or urine measurements reflecting bone formation or resorption. They provide information about bone turnover and may change with osteoporosis treatment; they measure different features from bone density and fracture-risk estimates.

Bone Marrow

Soft tissue inside many bones. Red marrow makes red cells, white cells, and platelets; yellow marrow stores fat and can produce more blood cells when the body needs them.

Bone Marrow Aspiration

Removal of a small amount of liquid marrow, usually from the back of the hipbone, with a needle. It is examined to assess blood-cell development, abnormal cells, infection, or genetic changes.

Bone Marrow Aspiration And Biopsy

Two ways of sampling marrow, usually from the back of the hipbone. Aspiration collects liquid marrow for cell and genetic testing; biopsy removes a small solid core to assess marrow structure, cell production, scarring, infection, or cancer.

Bone Marrow Biopsy

A procedure that removes marrow, usually from the back of the hipbone, for examination. It may include liquid aspiration and a solid core to assess blood-cell production, abnormal cells, scarring, infection, or cancer.

Bone Marrow Culture

A laboratory test in which marrow is placed in

special conditions to grow and identify bacteria, fungi, or other organisms when an infection of the marrow or bloodstream is suspected.

Bone Marrow Depression

Reduced production of blood cells by the marrow. It can cause anaemia, increased infection risk from too few white cells, bleeding from too few platelets, or a combination of these problems.

Bone Marrow Disorder

Any disease that affects the marrow's production of red cells, white cells, or platelets. It may cause anaemia, frequent infections, bleeding, abnormal blood counts, or symptoms from abnormal marrow cells.

Bone Marrow Donation

Collection of blood-forming stem cells from a donor's bone marrow, usually by aspiration from the pelvic bones under anaesthesia. It is one source of cells for transplantation and is distinct from peripheral blood stem-cell donation by apheresis.

Alternate Names:
Bone Marrow Harvest

Bone Marrow Edema

An MRI finding in which marrow has an abnormal signal that often reflects extra fluid or tissue injury. It is not a diagnosis by itself and may occur with injury, overuse, inflammation, reduced blood flow, or other conditions. The cause is judged from the scan and other findings.

Bone Marrow Failure

A condition in which the marrow cannot make enough red cells, white cells, or platelets. Causes include inherited disorders, aplastic anaemia, medicines, toxins, infections, marrow cancers, and other diseases.

Alternate Names:
Marrow Failure Bone Marrow Failure Syndrome

Bone Marrow Fibrosis

An increase in scar-like fibrous tissue within the bone marrow, where blood cells are made. It can disrupt normal blood-cell production and occur in myelofibrosis or as a result of other blood, cancer, inflammatory, or infectious disorders. A marrow sample can show the change.

Bone Marrow Hyperplasia

An increase in the number of marrow cells because blood-cell production has accelerated. It may be a response to ongoing red-cell destruction, blood loss, low oxygen, or another increased demand for blood cells.

Bone Marrow Necrosis

Death of the blood-forming tissue inside bones. It can occur with severe sickle-cell disease, blood cancers, or infection and may cause severe bone pain, anaemia, low white-cell or platelet counts, and fever.

Bone Marrow Transplantation

A treatment in which healthy blood-forming stem cells are infused to replace or restore bone-marrow cells damaged by disease or treatment. The cells may come from the patient or a donor. It is used for selected blood cancers, marrow failure, and some inherited disorders; risks include infection, graft failure, organ toxicity, and graft-versus-host disease after a donor transplant.

Alternate Names:
BMT; Bone Marrow Transplant

Bone-Marrow Transplantation

Alternate name; see *Bone Marrow Transplantation*.

Bone Mass

The amount of bone tissue in the skeleton or in a particular area. Greater bone mass generally provides more strength, while low bone mass can increase the risk of osteoporosis and fractures.

Alternate Names:
Bone Mineral Content; Skeletal Bone Mass

Bone Matrix

The material surrounding bone cells that gives bone its shape and strength. It contains a flexible frame-

work, mainly type I collagen, reinforced with mineral crystals made largely from calcium and phosphate.

Bone Metastases

Areas of cancer that have spread to bone from another part of the body. They may cause bone pain, weaken the bone and lead to fracture, raise blood calcium, or press on the spinal cord or nerves.

Alternate Names:
Metastatic Bone Disease; Skeletal Metastases

Bone Metastasis

See *Bone Metastases*.

Bone Mineral Density

The amount of mineral, mainly calcium, in a measured area of bone. A DXA scan estimates bone strength, helps diagnose osteoporosis, assesses fracture risk, and monitors treatment together with age and other risk factors.

Alternate Names:
BMD; Bone Density; Bone Mineral Content

Bone Mineral Density Test

A test that estimates the amount of mineral in bone, most commonly using dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry (DXA) at the hip and spine. Results help assess bone strength and fracture risk and support diagnosis or monitoring of osteoporosis.

Bone Morphogenetic Protein

A family of growth factors belonging to the transforming growth factor-beta (TGF-beta) superfamily that orchestrate osteogenesis, chondrogenesis, and bone remodeling, utilized therapeutically in spinal fusion and non-union fracture repair.

Alternate Names:
BMP

Bone Necrosis

Death of bone tissue, usually because its blood supply is reduced or because of severe injury, infection, radiation, or prolonged corticosteroid use. It can cause pain, bone collapse, joint damage, and fracture.

Bone Neoplasm

An abnormal growth of cells arising in bone. It may be noncancerous or cancerous; imaging and often a biopsy determine its type, behaviour, and extent.

Bone Tumors Of The Hip

Growths in the bones around the hip, including the pelvis and upper thighbone. They may start in bone or spread there from another part of the body; some are noncancerous and others are cancerous. See also *Bone Neoplasm* and *Bone Metastases*.

Bone Pain

Aching or other discomfort arising from bone. Causes include injury, fracture, infection, reduced blood supply, metabolic disease, overuse, or cancer. Persistent, severe, or unexplained pain can be associated with serious underlying disease.

Bone Pain Or Tenderness

Pain when a bone is used, pressed, or touched. It may result from injury, fracture, infection, inflammation, metabolic disease, or cancer.

Bone Plate

A metal or other body-compatible plate fixed to bone with screws. It holds broken pieces in position, supports healing, or helps correct a deformity during orthopaedic surgery.

Bone Regeneration

Formation of new bone to repair or replace bone that is damaged, missing, or diseased. It occurs naturally during fracture healing and may be supported by grafts, implants, or other treatments.

Bone Remodeling

The lifelong replacement of old bone with new bone. Cells remove worn bone and other cells build replacement bone, helping maintain strength, shape, and the body's calcium balance.

Bone Resorption

The removal and breakdown of bone tissue, which releases minerals into the blood. It is normal during

bone renewal, but excessive resorption can weaken bones and contribute to osteoporosis.

Bones And Joints

Bones provide support and protection, while joints connect bones and allow movement. Joints may be fixed, slightly movable, or freely movable and are held together by tissues such as cartilage, ligaments, and joint fluid.

Bone Sarcoma

A malignant tumour that begins in bone, such as osteosarcoma, chondrosarcoma, or Ewing sarcoma. It is distinct from cancer that spreads to bone from another organ.

Bone Saw

A surgical instrument used to cut bone during procedures such as amputation, joint replacement, fracture repair, or orthopaedic reconstruction.

Bone Scan

A specialized imaging test that uses a small, safe amount of radioactive substance (tracer) injected into a vein to look for areas of bone damage or abnormal bone turnover. A special camera scans the body to highlight spots where bone is healing, inflamed, or growing unusually fast, helping detect fractures, bone infections, arthritis, or cancer that has spread to bone.

Alternate Names:
Bone Scintigraphy; Skeletal Scintigraphy; Radionuclide Bone Scan

Bone Screws

Screws used during orthopaedic surgery to hold broken bone pieces together or attach plates, joint components, or other implants. Their size, material, and placement depend on the bone and the operation.

Bones of the Skeleton

The body's framework of bones and cartilage, providing support, protection, leverage for movement, mineral storage, and marrow-based blood-cell production.

Bone Spurs

Extra projections of bone that usually form near joints after long-term wear, arthritis, injury, or abnormal stress. They may cause no symptoms or may irritate nearby tissues and restrict movement.

Alternate Names:
Osteophytes

Bone Transplantation

Transfer of bone tissue or a bone substitute to repair a defect, support fracture healing, or assist reconstruction of the spine, jaw, or a joint. The graft may come from the person, a donor, or a manufactured material.

Bone Tumor

Alternate name; see *Bone Neoplasm*.

Bone Tumor-Epidermoid Cyst-Polyposis

A historical descriptive name for Gardner syndrome, an inherited adenomatous polyposis condition associated with numerous colorectal polyps, osteomas, epidermoid cysts, and a high risk of colorectal cancer.

Bone Turnover Markers

Substances measured in blood or urine that reflect how quickly bone is being built or broken down. They may support assessment of some metabolic bone disorders or treatment response but do not replace bone-density testing.

Bone Type

A way of grouping bones by shape. Long bones support movement, short bones provide stability, flat bones protect organs or provide broad muscle attachment, irregular bones have complex shapes, and sesamoid bones lie within tendons.

Bone X-Ray

An X-ray picture of a bone or group of bones used to look for fractures, abnormal shape, arthritis, infection, bone loss, or some tumours.

Bongkrek Poisoning

Severe poisoning caused by bongkrekic acid in contaminated fermented foods, especially coconut or corn products. It can cause vomiting, abdominal pain, weakness, liver failure, neurologic injury, and death.

Bonnevie-Ullrich Syndrome

An older name for the physical features sometimes associated with Turner syndrome, a condition involving an absent or altered X chromosome. Features may include short stature, a webbed neck, and reduced ovarian function.

Bony Exostosis

A localized extra growth of bone, often arising on the jaw or palate. It is usually benign and may cause a hard lump or interfere with nearby tissues, depending on its size and location.

Bony Labyrinth

A system of channels inside the dense part of the skull bone that houses the inner ear. It contains the cochlea for hearing and the vestibule and semicircular canals for balance.

Borborygmi

Rumbling or gurgling sounds made when gas and liquid move through the intestines. They are often normal, but major changes together with pain, vomiting, swelling, or inability to pass stool may signal bowel disease.

Borborygmus

A single rumbling or gurgling intestinal sound caused by movement of gas and liquid through the bowel. Its significance depends on symptoms and the overall abdominal examination.

Borderline

Describes a result or condition near the boundary between normal and abnormal or between diagnostic categories. It is an equivocal finding whose significance depends on the measurement, symptoms, and other clinical information.

Borderline Ovarian Cancer

An ovarian epithelial tumour with atypical proliferating cells but no destructive stromal invasion. It generally behaves less aggressively than invasive ovarian cancer, although recurrence can occur.

Borderline Personality Disorder

A mental disorder marked by an enduring pattern of instability in emotions, self-image, and relationships, often with impulsive behavior and difficulty regulating emotions. Features may include intense reactions to perceived abandonment, rapidly shifting moods, chronic emptiness, anger, or self-injury. Symptoms vary and cause significant distress or impairment.

Alternate Names:
BPD; Emotionally Unstable Personality Disorder (EUPD)

Bordetella

A group of small bacteria that can infect the airways of humans or animals. Bordetella pertussis causes whooping cough; other species usually affect animals but can rarely cause opportunistic human infection.

Bordetella Avium

A bacterium that mainly causes respiratory disease in turkeys and other birds. Human infection is very rare and is usually reported in people with weakened immunity or serious underlying illness.

Bordetella Bronchiseptica

A bacterium that commonly causes respiratory infection in dogs and other animals. It rarely infects humans, but may cause pneumonia or bloodstream infection, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Bordetella Hinzii

A bacterium found mainly in poultry. It rarely causes respiratory or bloodstream infection in humans, usually in people with weakened immunity or significant underlying disease.

Bordetella Parapertussis

A bacterium that can cause a whooping-cough-like respiratory infection. Illness is often milder than infection with Bordetella pertussis, but prolonged coughing can still occur and the infection can spread to others.

Bordetella Pertussis

The bacterium that causes whooping cough, a highly contagious respiratory infection. It attaches to airway lining, produces toxins that disrupt airway function, and can cause repeated coughing, vomiting, breathing pauses, and serious illness in infants.

Bordetella Petrii

An environmental bacterium that rarely causes human disease. When it is found in a specimen, clinicians decide whether it represents true infection by considering the body site, symptoms, and other test results.

Boric Acid

A chemical used in some industrial products, insecticides, and limited topical preparations. Swallowing it or absorbing a large amount can poison the body.

Boric Acid Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing or absorbing too much boric acid. It may cause vomiting, diarrhoea, abdominal pain, skin changes, kidney injury, seizures, shock, or death.

Borna Disease

An uncommon viral infection of the nervous system caused by Borna disease virus. It is mainly recognized in animals; human infection is rare and may cause severe inflammation of the brain.

Bornholm Disease

A contagious viral illness causing sudden attacks of severe chest or upper-abdominal muscle pain, often with fever, headache, or vomiting. It is usually caused by an enterovirus and generally resolves with supportive care.

Boron

A chemical element found naturally in food, water, soil, and industrial materials. Small dietary amounts are generally tolerated, but excessive exposure can cause digestive symptoms, skin problems, reproductive effects, or developmental toxicity.

Borrelia

A group of spiral-shaped bacteria spread mainly by ticks or lice. Different species cause Lyme disease, relapsing fever, or other infections, with symptoms and treatment depending on the species and exposure.

Borrelia Burgdorferi

A spiral-shaped bacterium spread by infected blacklegged ticks and the main cause of Lyme disease in North America and parts of Europe. Infection may affect the skin, joints, nervous system, or heart.

Borrelia Infection

Infection with a Borrelia bacterium. Depending on the species, it may cause Lyme disease or relapsing fever, with symptoms such as fever, headache, fatigue, rash, muscle pain, or joint and nerve problems.

Borrelia Miyamotoi

A bacterium spread by some hard-bodied ticks that causes hard-tick relapsing fever. Illness commonly includes repeated episodes of fever, headache, fatigue, chills, and muscle or joint aches.

Borreliosis

Infection caused by a Borrelia bacterium. Human forms include Lyme disease and relapsing fever; symptoms differ according to the species, stage of infection, route of spread, and organs involved.

Bortezomib

A cancer medicine that blocks proteasomes, cell structures that remove unwanted proteins. This can kill susceptible cancer cells and is used mainly for multiple myeloma and some lymphomas; nerve damage, low blood counts, digestive symptoms, and infections can occur.

Bosentan

A medicine that blocks endothelin, a substance that narrows blood vessels. It is used for pulmonary arterial hypertension and can cause liver injury or harm a developing fetus.

Bosniak Classification

A system for describing kidney cysts on contrast CT or MRI according to their walls, septations, mineral deposits, and solid parts. Categories help estimate cancer risk and guide monitoring, further imaging, or surgery.

Boston Criteria

Clinical and brain-imaging rules used to estimate the likelihood of cerebral amyloid angiopathy in living people. Age, symptoms, and MRI findings such as bleeding in certain parts of the brain are considered. The criteria classify cases as possible or probable; definite diagnosis generally requires examination of brain tissue.

Alternate Names:
Boston Criteria for Cerebral Amyloid Angiopathy

Bot Fly

Alternate spelling; see *Botfly*.

Botfly

A dipteran fly of the family Oestridae (notably *Dermatobia hominis*, the human botfly) whose parasitic larvae infest mammalian skin and tissues, producing obligate furuncular or wound myiasis. In humans, the larva develops within the dermis, causing an erythematous, tender, boil-like nodule featuring a central punctum for larval respiration, frequently accompanied by serosanguinous drainage and localized sensations of movement.

Bothriocephalus

An older name for a group of fish tapeworms. Related tapeworm infections may cause abdominal symptoms and, when prolonged, can reduce vitamin B12 absorption and lead to anaemia.

Botryomycosis

A chronic bacterial infection that forms firm granules within lesions and can resemble a fungal infection. It most often affects the skin and tissue beneath it but may involve internal organs, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Bottle Feeding

Feeding an infant expressed breast milk or infant formula from a bottle.

Botulinum Toxin

A substance made by Clostridium botulinum that temporarily blocks nerve signals to muscles and some glands. Carefully measured injections treat selected muscle spasms, movement disorders, migraine, sweating, and cosmetic concerns; too much can cause weakness or breathing failure.

Botulism

A rare, life-threatening illness caused by toxins produced by the bacterium extitClostridium botulinum. The toxin attacks the nervous system by blocking the nerve signals that tell muscles to move. It causes paralysis that typically starts in the face—leading to drooping eyelids, blurred or double vision, and difficulty speaking or swallowing—and spreads downward to the arms, legs, and breathing muscles. It can occur from eating improperly canned or preserved food, from infected wounds, or in infants who swallow bacterial spores.

Alternate Names:
Clostridial Botulism; Botulinum Poisoning

Bouchard Nodes

Hard, bony enlargements (osteophytes) of the proximal interphalangeal (PIP) joints of the hands, characteristic of osteoarthritis. They result from articular cartilage degeneration, subchondral sclerosis, and reactive marginal osteophyte formation, causing localized stiffness, reduced range of motion, and angular deviation (distinguished from Heberden nodes of the distal interphalangeal joints).

Alternate Names:
Proximal Interphalangeal Osteophytes; PIP-Joint Nodes; Bouchard's Nodes

Bouchard's Node

Singular form; see *Bouchard Nodes*.

Bouchard's Nodes

Alternate spelling; see *Bouchard Nodes*.

Bougie

A slender medical instrument used to examine or gradually widen a narrowed passage, such as the food pipe or urethra. Use can cause pain, bleeding, perforation, or infection.

Bougienage

Gradual widening or examination of a narrowed body passage with a bougie. It may relieve swallowing or urinary obstruction; complications include bleeding or perforation.

Bouin's Solution

A laboratory liquid containing picric acid, formaldehyde, and acetic acid that preserves tissue for microscopic examination. It is hazardous to handle and can interfere with some later genetic tests.

Bounding Pulse

A hyperdynamic, high-amplitude arterial pulse characterized by a rapid, forceful upstroke and wide pulse pressure (Corrigan or water-hammer pulse), classically associated with aortic regurgitation, thyrotoxicosis, severe anemia, fever, patent ductus arteriosus, or septic shock.

Alternate Names:
Hyperdynamic Pulse; Water-Hammer Pulse; Corrigan Pulse

Bourbon Virus

A rare tick-associated viral infection that can cause fever, tiredness, poor appetite, nausea, and low white-cell or platelet counts. No specific treatment or vaccine is established; reported care is supportive, and symptoms can overlap with other serious infections.

Boutonneuse Fever

A tick-borne infection caused usually by Rickettsia conorii. It commonly causes fever, headache, rash, and a dark sore at the bite site; untreated infection can cause serious illness.

Boutonniere Deformity

A finger shape problem where the middle joint stays bent inward and the tip bends backward, often caused by an injury or rheumatoid arthritis.

Bouveret Syndrome

A rare blockage near the stomach outlet caused by a gallstone that has entered the intestine through an abnormal connection from the gallbladder. It can cause persistent vomiting, upper-abdominal pain, bloating, and inability to eat.

Bovine

Relating to cattle or to material obtained from cattle. In medicine it may describe an animal disease, a biological product, tissue used in treatment, or an infection that can pass between cattle and people.

Bovine Anaplasmosis

A tick- or blood-spread infection of cattle caused by Anaplasma marginale. The bacterium infects red blood cells and destroys them, causing anaemia, weakness, fever, reduced milk production, or death.

Bovine Papillomavirus

A group of papillomaviruses that infect cattle and can cause skin warts or other growths. Different strains vary in their effects; human disease is not the usual concern.

Bovine Spongiform Encephalopathy

A fatal disease of cattle caused by misfolded proteins called prions. It progressively damages the brain and nervous system; people can rarely develop variant Creutzfeldt–Jakob disease after eating contaminated cattle tissue.

Bowditch Effect

The intrinsic autoregulatory property of cardiac muscle whereby an increase in heart rate leads to a progressive, stepwise increase in the force of myocar-

dial contraction due to intracellular accumulation of calcium ions.

Alternate Names:
Treppe Phenomenon; Frequency-Dependent Inotropy

Bowel

The small and large intestines. They receive partly digested food, absorb nutrients and water, move contents forward, and form and store stool before it leaves the body.

Bowel Cancer

Cancer arising in the colon or rectum. It may cause a persistent change in bowel habit, blood in stool, anaemia, weight loss, abdominal pain, or no early symptoms.

Bowel Death

Alternate name; see *Bowel Infarction*.

Bowel Disorders

Pathological conditions affecting the small or large intestine, encompassing inflammatory bowel disease (Crohn disease, ulcerative colitis), infectious enterocolitis, ischemic bowel disease, bowel obstruction, and colorectal neoplasms.

Alternate Names:
Intestinal Diseases; Bowel Diseases; Intestinal Disorders

Bowel Habit Changes and Bloating

A group of digestive symptoms consisting of diarrhea, constipation, gas, and abdominal bloating. They may result from diet, infection, medicines, food intolerance, or disorders such as irritable bowel syndrome; persistent, severe, bloody, or unexplained symptoms can be associated with underlying disease.

Bowel Habits

A person's usual pattern of passing stool, including how often it happens and the stool's form and ease of passage. Changes may include new constipation, diarrhea, urgency, or a different pattern.

Bowel Incontinence

Alternate name; see *Fecal Incontinence*.

Bowel Infarction

Death of part of the intestine because its blood supply is blocked or severely reduced. It can cause severe abdominal pain, bloody stool, vomiting, and abdominal tenderness and is a life-threatening emergency.

Bowel Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to the intestine, causing injury from too little oxygen. It may cause sudden or worsening abdominal pain, vomiting, or bloody stool and can progress to bowel death if circulation is not restored.

Bowel Movement

The passing of stool from the rectum through the anus. Stool frequency and form vary among healthy people.

Bowel Obstruction

A blockage that prevents food, fluid, and gas from moving through the intestine. It can cause cramping pain, swelling, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas and may lead to bowel damage or perforation.

Bowel Preparation

Emptying and cleansing the colon before a colonoscopy or other bowel procedure, usually with dietary changes and a laxative solution. The quality of preparation affects how well lesions can be seen.

Alternate Names:
Bowel Prep; Colon Cleansing; Colonic Preparation

Bowel Program

A planned routine using food, fluids, medicines, movement, and scheduled toilet visits to produce regular bowel movements and manage constipation or loss of bowel control.

Bowel Retraining

A structured routine that uses regular toilet times, suitable food and fluids, physical activity, and help-

ful posture to establish predictable bowel movements and improve constipation or bowel-control problems.

Bowel Resection

Surgical removal of a diseased, obstructed, or ischemic section of the intestine (small bowel or colon); see *Small Bowel Resection*, *Large Bowel Resection*, and *Colectomy*.

Bowel Sounds

Gurgling or clicking sounds made as the intestines move gas and liquid. Their presence and pattern can provide clues during an abdominal examination but cannot diagnose a disorder by themselves.

Bowel Transit Time

The time food and other contents take to travel through the digestive tract. Testing it can help investigate unusually slow or fast movement when a bowel-movement or digestive disorder is suspected.

Bowel Urgency

A sudden, hard-to-delay need to pass stool. It can occur with diarrhoea, infection, irritable bowel syndrome, inflammatory bowel disease, or disorders of the rectum and may lead to accidents.

Bowenoid Papulosis

An HPV-associated squamous intraepithelial lesion of genital or perianal skin, usually presenting as multiple reddish-brown or violaceous papules. Biopsy shows atypical cells resembling squamous-cell carcinoma in situ, although many lesions behave indolently.

Bowen's Disease

Squamous cell carcinoma in situ, an early form of non-melanoma skin cancer confined to the epidermis. It classically presents as a slowly enlarging, well-demarcated, erythematous, scaly or crusted plaque, most commonly on sun-exposed areas. Full-thickness epidermal dysplasia is present on biopsy; if left untreated, approximately 3–5% progress to invasive squamous cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Squamous Cell Carcinoma in Situ; Bowen's Disease

Bow Legs

An angular deformational alignment of the lower extremity characterized by outward lateral bowing of the tibia and femur such that the knees remain abnormally separated when the medial malleoli of the ankles are approximated.

Alternate Names:
Genu Varum; Bowlegs; Bandy Legs

Bowlegs

Alternate name; see *Bow Legs*.

Bowler's Thumb

Irritation or scarring of the digital nerve along the thumb caused by repeated pressure from a bowling ball. It may produce pain, numbness, tingling, or a tender lump and may improve with rest or equipment changes.

Bowman Capsule

A cup-shaped structure at the beginning of each kidney filtering unit. It surrounds a knot of tiny blood vessels and collects the fluid filtered from blood before it passes through the rest of the kidney tubule.

Bowman Membrane

A thin, strong layer near the front of the cornea that supports and protects the eye's clear surface. Significant injury can scar it because it does not normally grow back.

Bowman's Capsule

The cup-shaped beginning of a kidney filtering unit. It surrounds a cluster of small blood vessels and receives the fluid filtered from blood.

Bowman's Gland

A small gland high inside the nose that releases watery fluid onto the smell-sensing lining. The fluid helps dissolve scent molecules and clear the surface so odours can be detected.

Boxed Warning

The strongest safety warning required in a medicine's prescribing information when there is a serious or life-threatening risk. It explains a major hazard but does not necessarily mean the medicine is unsuitable for every patient.

Boxer Fracture

A transverse or comminuted fracture through the distal metaphysis or neck of the fifth metacarpal bone (and occasionally the fourth metacarpal), characteristically accompanied by volar angulation of the metacarpal head resulting from direct axial loading with a clenched fist.

Boxer's Ear

A deformity of the outer ear caused by repeated injury or untreated blood collection around the ear cartilage. It can produce thickened, scarred tissue with a cauliflower-like appearance.

Boxer's Fracture

A break near the knuckle end of the fifth metacarpal, the hand bone below the little finger. It commonly follows punching and causes pain, swelling, tenderness, or a changed knuckle shape.

BPH (Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia)

Abbreviation; see *Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia*.

Braces and Retainers

Alternate name; see *Dental Braces*.

Brachial

Relating to the upper arm, including its bones, muscles, blood vessels, and nerves. The brachial artery supplies the arm, and the brachial plexus carries nerve signals to and from the arm and hand.

Brachial Artery

The main artery of the upper arm. It carries blood from the armpit toward the elbow, where it divides into the radial and ulnar arteries, and it is commonly used to measure a pulse or blood pressure.

Brachialgia

Pain that travels from the neck or shoulder down the arm. It often results from irritation of a neck nerve or the brachial plexus and may occur with numbness, tingling, or weakness.

Brachialis Muscle

A strong muscle at the front of the upper arm, beneath the biceps. It is the main muscle that bends the elbow and works whether the palm faces up, down, or sideways.

Brachial Plexopathy

Damage or dysfunction of the nerve network supplying the shoulder, arm, and hand. It can cause pain, weakness, numbness, or paralysis after injury, pressure, inflammation, a tumour, or radiation.

Brachial Plexus

A network of nerves formed mainly by the ventral rami of spinal nerves C5–T1. It supplies motor and sensory innervation to the shoulder and upper limb. Its fibers pass through roots, trunks, divisions, and cords before forming terminal branches. These include the musculocutaneous, axillary, radial, median, and ulnar nerves.

Brachial Plexus Cords

Three parts of the nerve network supplying the arm, named lateral, posterior, and medial because of their position around an artery in the armpit. They join to form nerves controlling movement and feeling in the upper limb.

Brachial Plexus Injuries

Damage to the nerve network supplying the shoulder and upper limb, caused by stretching, pressure, or a penetrating injury. Symptoms range from pain or numbness to weakness or paralysis, depending on the nerves affected.

Brachial Plexus Injury

Damage to the nerve network of the shoulder and arm, sometimes occurring during a difficult birth or after trauma. It may cause weakness, loss of movement, numbness, or paralysis; recovery depends on

the severity and nerves involved.

Brachial Plexus Injury In Newborns

Damage to the nerves supplying a newborn's shoulder, arm, and hand, usually associated with birth. The affected arm may be weak or still; severity ranges from temporary weakness to permanent loss of movement or sensation.

Brachial Plexus Neuropathies

Disorders affecting the nerve network that supplies the shoulder, arm, and hand. They can cause pain, weakness, numbness, or loss of movement because of injury, pressure, inflammation, tumours, or radiation.

Brachial Plexus Roots

The first portions of the nerve network that supplies the arm, arising from the lower neck and upper chest. Damage to different roots produces characteristic patterns of weakness, numbness, and pain.

Brachial Plexus Trunks

Three sections of the brachial plexus—upper, middle, and lower—that carry nerve fibres toward the arm. Injury to the upper trunk can cause weakness of the shoulder and elbow, while lower-trunk injury can mainly affect the hand.

Brachial Vein

Deep veins accompanying the brachial artery that drain the arm and join the basilic vein to form the axillary vein.

Brachiocephalic Artery

The first and largest arterial branch arising from the aortic arch, which ascends obliquely behind the manubrium of the sternum before bifurcating into the right common carotid and right subclavian arteries.

Alternate Names:
Innominate Artery

Brachiocephalic Trunk

The first large branch of the aorta in the chest. It carries blood toward the right side of the head, neck, and arm and divides into the right common carotid and right subclavian arteries.

Brachiocephalic Veins

Two large veins formed by the joining of veins from the head, neck, and arm. They drain blood from these areas into the superior vena cava, which returns it to the heart.

Brachioplasty

An operation to remove or reshape excess skin and tissue of the upper arm. Possible complications include scars, altered sensation, bleeding, fluid collection, infection, and wound problems.

Common name: Arm Lift

Brachioradialis Reflex

A deep tendon stretch reflex elicited by briskly tapping the tendon of the brachioradialis muscle near the styloid process of the radius with a reflex hammer, producing forearm flexion and slight pronation. It is innervated by the radial nerve and tests the integrity of the C5 and C6 cervical spinal cord segments and nerve roots.

Alternate Names:
Supinator Reflex; Radial Reflex

Brachioradial Pruritus

A localized neuropathic itch, burning, or tingling affecting the outer forearms, often associated with irritation of cervical nerve roots, especially C4–C6. The skin may look normal or show scratch marks from rubbing.

Brachium

The part of the upper limb between the shoulder and elbow. It contains the upper-arm bone, muscles that move the shoulder and elbow, and major nerves and blood vessels.

Brachycephalic

Describes a skull that is relatively short from front to back and broad from side to side. It may be a normal family characteristic or part of a condition

affecting skull growth.

Brachycephaly

A broad, short skull shape. It may develop from pressure on an infant's head or from early joining of skull bones; effects on brain growth vary with the cause.

Brachydactyly

A birth condition in which one or more fingers or toes are shorter than usual because of altered development of their bones or surrounding tissues. It may occur alone or as part of an inherited syndrome.

Brachytherapy

Internal radiation treatment in which a radioactive source is placed inside or close to a tumour. It delivers a concentrated dose to a limited area and may use a temporary applicator or a source left in place permanently.

Alternate Names:
Brachy Therapy Internal Radiation Therapy

Brachytherapy Seed

A tiny radioactive source placed in or near a tumour to deliver local radiation. Seeds may be temporary or permanent and are used most often for selected cancers, including prostate cancer.

Bradyarrhythmia

A heart rhythm disorder with an abnormally slow rate or slow conduction. Causes include sinus-node dysfunction and atrioventricular block; the rate alone does not determine whether it is clinically significant.

Alternate Names:
Bradycardia Arrhythmia

Bradycardia

A slower-than-usual heart rate, often below 60 beats per minute in adults. It can be normal during sleep or in trained athletes, but may result from heart-conduction disease or medicines and cause dizziness, fainting, tiredness, or breathlessness.

Bradycardia Of Prematurity

A slow heart rate in a premature infant, often occurring with pauses in breathing and low oxygen. It commonly reflects immature breathing and heart control and is monitored and treated according to its frequency and severity.

Bradycardia (Slow Heart Rate)

Alternate name; see *Bradycardia*.

Bradycardia-Tachycardia Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sick Sinus Syndrome*.

Bradykinesia

Slowness and reduced size of voluntary movements. It can make starting or repeating actions difficult and may occur with stiffness, tremor, reduced arm swing, a less expressive face, or a shuffling walk in Parkinson disease and related disorders.

Bradykinesia and Athetosis

Hypokinetic and dyskinetic movement patterns characterized by generalized slowness of movement initiation (bradykinesia) or continuous slow, writhing, twisting involuntary movements (athetosis), frequently observed in Parkinson disease, secondary parkinsonism, or basal ganglia encephalopathies.

Alternate Names:
Slowness of Movement; Hypokinesia and Athetosis; Extrapyramidal Slowness

Bradykinetic

Describes abnormally slow movement, especially the reduced speed and size of movement seen in Parkinson disease and related neurologic disorders.

Bradykinin

A natural chemical messenger that widens some blood vessels and allows more fluid to leave them. It contributes to inflammation, swelling, pain, and rare reactions to certain blood-pressure medicines.

Bradyphrenia

Unusually slow thinking or mental processing. It may cause delayed responses and difficulty complet-

ing tasks and can occur with neurologic disease, mental illness, medicines, depression, or other conditions.

Bradypnea

Abnormally slow breathing, often fewer than 12 breaths per minute in an adult. It may result from sedative or opioid effects, brain disease, low body temperature, hormone disorders, or severe illness and can lead to respiratory failure.

Bradypnoea

Abnormally slow breathing. Causes include medicines, neurologic disease, metabolic disturbance, low body temperature, or severe illness; difficult, shallow breathing or confusion may occur in serious cases.

BRAF Gene

A gene that encodes a signaling protein in the RAS-RAF-MEK-ERK pathway, which regulates cell growth and division. Activating BRAF variants can drive cancers such as melanoma, thyroid cancer, and colorectal cancer and may guide targeted treatment.

Braille System

A raised-dot writing and reading system used by people who are blind or have low vision. Patterns represent letters, numbers, punctuation, and symbols and can be read by touch.

Brain

The main organ of the nervous system, protected inside the skull. It processes senses, controls movement and body functions, and supports thinking, memory, emotions, language, and consciousness.

Brain Abscess

A pocket of pus and infection inside the brain. It can develop when infection spreads from the blood, nearby ear or sinus disease, surgery, or an injury and may cause headache, fever, seizures, or weakness.

Brain Aneurysm

A weakened bulge in an artery supplying the brain. If it bursts, it can cause sudden severe headache, vomiting, neck stiffness, collapse, or other neurological problems.

Brain Aneurysm Repair

Treatment to prevent a brain aneurysm from bleeding or bleeding again. A surgeon may place a clip or a specialist may seal the aneurysm from inside the artery with coils or another device.

Brain Arteriovenous Malformation

A tangle of blood vessels in the brain where arteries connect directly to veins without the usual tiny connecting vessels. It may cause no symptoms, but can bleed or cause seizures, headaches, or weakness.

Alternate Names:
Cerebral Arteriovenous Malformation; Brain AVM; Intracranial AVM

Brain AVM

Alternate name; see *Brain Arteriovenous Malformation*.

Brain Atrophy

Alternate name; see *Cerebral Atrophy*.

Brain Biopsy

A surgical procedure in which a small sample of brain tissue is removed for diagnostic microscopic and histological evaluation; see *Stereotactic Brain Biopsy* and *Biopsy*.

Brain Cancer

Cancer affecting brain tissue or its coverings. Symptoms depend on the location and may include seizures, headache, weakness, speech or vision changes, personality change, or pressure-related vomiting; diagnosis usually requires brain imaging and sometimes tissue testing.

Alternate Names:
Malignant Brain Tumor; Primary Brain Neoplasm

Brain Concussion

Alternate name; see *Concussion*.

Brain Death

Permanent loss of all functions of the brain, including the brainstem. Once formally determined according to applicable medical standards and law, it means the person has died.

Brain Disorder

Any illness or abnormality affecting the brain's structure or function, including stroke, infection, tumour, epilepsy, injury, degenerative disease, or a condition present from birth.

Brain Edema

Swelling caused by extra fluid in brain tissue. It can increase pressure inside the skull after injury, stroke, infection, bleeding, tumour, or severe illness and may cause headache, vomiting, seizures, confusion, or reduced consciousness.

Brain Embolism

Alternate name; see *Embolic Stroke*.

Brain Fog

An informal description of difficulty concentrating, thinking clearly, remembering, or finding words. It is a symptom rather than a diagnosis and may occur with poor sleep, stress, illness, medicines, depression, or other conditions.

Brain Fornix

A curved bundle of nerve fibres deep in the brain that helps connect the hippocampus with other areas involved in memory. Damage may cause difficulty learning or remembering information.

Brain Haemorrhage

Alternate spelling; see *Brain Hemorrhage*.

Brain Health

A broad term for the brain's ability to support thinking, memory, learning, movement, emotions, communication, and consciousness, and for the factors that affect these functions.

Brain Hemorrhage

Bleeding within or around the brain, often caused by high blood pressure, an aneurysm, a blood-vessel malformation, injury, or blood-thinning treatment. It may cause sudden severe headache, weakness, speech trouble, vomiting, seizure, or reduced consciousness.

Brain Herniation

Dangerous displacement of brain tissue caused by severe swelling, bleeding, a tumour, or another increase in pressure inside the skull. It can compress the brainstem and impair breathing and consciousness.

Brain Imaging

Tests that create pictures of brain structure or activity. CT and MRI show tissue, bleeding, swelling, tumours, and strokes; blood-vessel or nuclear scans answer more specific questions.

Alternate Names:
Neuroimaging; Cerebral Imaging

Brain Injuries

Alternate name; see *Brain Injury*.

Brain Injury

Damage or impaired function of the brain caused by trauma, lack of oxygen, stroke, infection, toxins, or another disease. Effects vary with the location and severity and may affect movement, sensation, thinking, behaviour, or consciousness.

Brain Lesions

Areas of brain tissue that look or function abnormally because of a tumour, stroke, infection, inflammation, injury, loss of nerve insulation, or a blood-vessel disorder. Symptoms depend mainly on the lesion's location and size.

Brain Malformations

Structural differences in the brain that develop before birth. They may result from genetic changes, disrupted fetal development, infection, or other prenatal influences and can affect movement, learning,

seizures, or other neurologic functions.

Brain Mapping

Methods used to identify where brain functions and structures are located. Imaging, electrical recordings, or direct stimulation may guide research or help surgeons avoid important areas during selected operations.

Brain Metastases

Cancer deposits that have spread to the brain from another organ. They may cause headache, seizures, weakness, speech or vision changes, confusion, or no symptoms and are assessed with brain imaging.

Brain Metastasis

Alternate singular form; see *Brain Metastases*.

Brain Monitoring

Repeated or continuous recording of brain activity, pressure inside the skull, or oxygen levels in brain tissue. Methods include electroencephalography (EEG) to assess seizures, sleep, or anaesthesia and intracranial-pressure monitoring after brain injury.

Brain MRI

A noninvasive magnetic resonance imaging scan of the head that generates cross-sectional images of the brain and surrounding tissues without ionizing radiation; see *MRI Brain*.

Brain Natriuretic Peptide Test

A blood test measuring BNP or NT-proBNP, substances released when the heart is stretched. A raised result can support a diagnosis of heart failure; levels are affected by symptoms, age, kidney function, and other findings.

Brain Neoplasm

An abnormal intracranial growth arising within the brain parenchyma (e.g., gliomas, neuronal-glial tumors), the meninges (meningioma), or cranial nerves, or secondary to metastatic spread from systemic malignancies (most frequently lung, breast, melanoma, or renal cell carcinoma). Manifestations arise from elevated intracranial pressure (early-morning headache, projectile vomiting, papilledema) or focal parenchymal compression causing seizures, focal neurological deficits, cognitive changes, or personality alterations.

Brain Neoplasms

Plural form; see *Brain Neoplasm*.

Brain PET Scan

A scan that uses a small amount of radioactive tracer to show chemical activity in the brain. It can help investigate selected tumours, memory disorders, seizures, or brain function when other scans do not answer the question.

Brain Sand

Brain sand is an older name for corpora arenacea, tiny calcified deposits commonly found in the pineal gland and sometimes other brain regions.

Brain SPECT

A nuclear-imaging scan that uses a radioactive tracer to map regional brain blood flow or, with specific tracers, other brain functions. It can help locate a seizure focus in selected people with epilepsy and assess blood-flow patterns in some dementia evaluations.

Brain Stem

Alternate spelling; see *Brainstem*.

Brainstem

The lower part of the brain that connects the upper brain to the spinal cord. It helps control breathing, heartbeat, blood pressure, swallowing, and alertness. It also carries signals between the brain and the rest of the body.

Brainstem Auditory Evoked Potential

A hearing test that records electrical responses along the auditory nerve and brainstem after sounds are played. It helps assess hearing, especially in newborns or people unable to complete standard hearing tests, and can detect dysfunction along the auditory

pathway.

Alternate Names:
BAEP; Brainstem Auditory Evoked Response; BAER

Brainstem Auditory Evoked Response

Alternate name; see *Brainstem Auditory Evoked Potential*.

Brainstem Death

A term used in some jurisdictions for death diagnosed by permanent loss of brainstem function. Definitions and legal criteria vary; in many jurisdictions, death by neurologic criteria requires permanent loss of all functions of the entire brain, including the brainstem. See *Brain Death*.

Brain Stem Glioma

Alternate spelling; see *Brainstem Gliomas*.

Brainstem Gliomas

Gliomas arising in the midbrain, pons, or medulla. They may affect eye movements, facial function, swallowing, balance, strength, or breathing; imaging and tumor biology guide diagnosis and management, which differs between children and adults.

Brainstem Tumor

A growth arising in the brainstem, which connects the brain with the spinal cord and controls important functions. Symptoms may include problems with eye movement, balance, swallowing, speech, strength, or breathing.

Brain Stimulation

Use of electrical, magnetic, or other energy to change brain activity. Methods include electroconvulsive therapy, transcranial magnetic stimulation, and deep-brain stimulation; their uses, benefits, and risks differ.

Brain Surgery

An operation on the brain or nearby structures to remove or sample a tumor, relieve pressure, treat bleeding, repair an abnormal blood vessel, or control selected seizures. Risks depend on the area and procedure and can include bleeding, infection, or neurologic loss.

Brain Tumor

An abnormal growth of cells in the brain or its coverings. It may be benign or malignant, begin in the brain, or spread there from cancer elsewhere. It can cause symptoms by affecting nearby tissue, blocking fluid flow, bleeding, or raising pressure inside the skull; symptoms may include seizures, headache, vomiting, weakness, or changes in thinking.

Brain Tumor Resection

The surgical removal (excision) of a benign or malignant brain neoplasm, typically performed via craniotomy; see *Craniotomy* and *Brain Tumor*.

Brain Tumors in Adults

Tumors arising in or near the adult brain, including primary gliomas, meningiomas, metastases, and other lesions. Symptoms depend on location and may include headache, seizures, weakness, personality change, vision problems, or cognitive decline.

Brain Tumour

Alternate spelling; see *Brain Tumor*.

Brain Ventricles

Four connected spaces inside the brain that contain and circulate cerebrospinal fluid. This fluid cushions the brain and spinal cord, carries substances, and helps remove waste; blockage can cause pressure and hydrocephalus.

Brain Wave

A rhythmic pattern of electrical activity generated by synchronized postsynaptic potentials of cerebral neurons, recorded on an electroencephalogram (EEG). Brain waves are classified into frequency bands: delta (0.5–4 Hz, slow-wave sleep), theta (4–8 Hz, drowsiness), alpha (8–13 Hz, relaxed wakefulness with eyes closed), beta (13–30 Hz, active focus), and gamma ($>$ 30 Hz, cognitive processing). Alterations in wave frequency, voltage, or symmetry aid in diagnosing epilepsy, sleep disorders, en-

cephalopathies, and brain death.

Alternate Names:
Cerebral Electrical Activity; EEG Rhythms

Brain Waves

Plural form; see *Brain Wave*.

Branchial

Relating to structures that develop from the paired tissue arches in an embryo's early head and neck. These arches contribute to parts of the face, throat, voice box, muscles, bones, blood vessels, and nerves.

Branchial Arch

One of several paired structures in an embryo that develop into parts of the face, throat, voice box, muscles, bones, blood vessels, and nerves of the head and neck.

Branchial Cleft

A groove between developing head-and-neck arches in an embryo. If part of it remains after birth, it may form a cyst, a narrow passage, or an opening, usually on the side of the neck.

Branchial Cleft Anomalies

Alternate name; see *Branchial Cleft Anomaly*.

Branchial Cleft Anomaly

A congenital remnant of the embryonic branchial apparatus that forms a cyst, blind-ending sinus, or tract connecting the throat and skin (fistula), usually along the side of the neck. Most arise from the second branchial cleft and may cause a neck lump, recurrent infection, or drainage.

Branchial Cleft Cyst

A fluid-filled lump on the side of the neck that is present from birth, though it may not be noticed until later. It forms when tissue from early development does not disappear. It can become swollen or painful if infected.

Branchial Cyst

Alternate name; see *Branchial Cleft Cyst*.

Branchioma

A rare cyst or growth arising from tissue related to early head-and-neck development. It often appears as a lump along the side of the neck.

Branchio-Oto-Renal Syndrome

An inherited disorder that can cause neck cysts or openings, hearing loss, and kidney abnormalities. The combination and severity vary, and some affected people have only one or two of these features.

Brass-Founder's Ague

An older name for metal-fume fever, a short-lived flu-like illness after breathing fumes from heated metals such as zinc or brass. Symptoms may include fever, chills, headache, muscle aches, cough, and nausea.

Braxton Hicks Contractions

Irregular tightening of the uterus during pregnancy, often becoming more noticeable later in pregnancy. Unlike labour contractions, they usually do not steadily strengthen or cause progressive cervical dilation.

Alternate Names:
False Labor; Practice Contractions

Brazilian Pemphigus Foliaceus

An endemic form of superficial pemphigus seen especially in parts of Brazil. Autoimmune attack on epidermal cell connections causes fragile superficial blisters and erosions without the deep mucosal disease typical of pemphigus vulgaris.

Common name: Fogo Selvagem

Brazilian Trypanosomiasis

Chagas disease, a parasitic infection caused by *Trypanosoma cruzi*. It is transmitted mainly by triatomine insects or congenitally and may later cause cardiomyopathy, arrhythmias, megaesophagus, or megacolon.

BRCA

BRCA1 and BRCA2 are genes that help repair damaged DNA. An inherited harmful change in either gene increases the risk of breast, ovarian,

fallopian-tube, primary peritoneal, prostate, and pancreatic cancers.

BRCA1 And BRCA2

Genes that help repair breaks in DNA and limit abnormal cell growth. An inherited harmful variant raises the risk of several cancers and may affect screening, preventive surgery, and treatment choices for the person and relatives.

BRCA1 And BRCA2 Gene Testing

A blood or saliva test looking for harmful inherited changes in BRCA1 or BRCA2. Results can guide cancer screening, preventive options, and treatment and may provide important information for biological relatives.

BRCA1 Gene

A gene involved in repairing damaged DNA and limiting tumor formation. An inherited harmful variant increases the risk of breast, ovarian, fallopian-tube, peritoneal, prostate, and pancreatic cancers; genetic counseling helps interpret test results.

BRCA2 Gene

A gene that helps repair serious DNA damage. An inherited harmful variant increases the risk of breast, ovarian, prostate, pancreatic, and some other cancers and may affect relatives; genetic counseling helps explain testing and options.

Breakbone Fever

An older name for dengue fever, reflecting the severe muscle and joint pain that may occur with this mosquito-borne viral infection. Fever, headache, rash, nausea, or dangerous bleeding may also develop.

Breakthrough Bleeding

Unscheduled uterine bleeding or spotting during use of hormonal contraception or hormone therapy. It can occur with combined or progestin-only methods, and its timing and duration vary by method and by how long it has been used.

Breakthrough Infection

An infection that occurs despite vaccination or another preventive measure intended to reduce its risk. Protection and illness severity vary with the germ, intervention, timing, and person's immune system.

Breakthrough Pain

A short flare of pain that occurs despite otherwise controlled persistent pain. It may happen unexpectedly or be triggered by activity or procedures.

Breast

One of the two organs on the front of the chest, made of milk-producing tissue, ducts, fat, connective tissue, blood vessels, nerves, and skin. It can be affected by benign conditions and cancer.

Breast Abscess

A localized collection of pus within breast tissue, usually caused by infection. It may occur during lactation or outside it and can cause a tender lump, redness, warmth, or fever.

Breast Anatomy

The breast contains skin, fat, milk-producing lobules, ducts, connective tissue, blood vessels, nerves, and lymph vessels that extend toward the armpit. Its appearance changes with age, hormones, pregnancy, and breastfeeding.

Breast And Thoracic Cancer Surgery

Operations for cancers of the breast or chest, including selected cancers of the lung, pleura, food pipe, mediastinum, or chest wall. Surgery may remove a tumour and nearby lymph nodes, with further treatment based on the cancer type and stage.

Alternate Names:
Breast and Thoracic Oncologic Surgery

Breast Augmentation

A procedure to increase breast size or change its shape, usually with an implant or transferred fat. Risks include infection, bleeding, scarring, altered sensation, implant problems, and the need for further surgery.

Alternate Names:
Breast Enlargement; Augmentation Mammoplasty

Breast Augmentation Surgery

An operation that enlarges or reshapes the breasts using implants or transferred tissue. Possible risks include infection, bleeding, scarring, altered sensation, implant problems, and later procedures.

Breast Biopsy

A diagnostic procedure in which a tissue sample is removed from a suspicious breast lump or lesion for microscopic evaluation by a pathologist; see *Biopsy* and *Stereotactic Breast Biopsy*.

Breast Bone

A common name for the breastbone, or sternum, a flat bone in the centre of the chest. It joins the ribs and helps protect the heart and lungs.

Breast Calcifications

Small calcium deposits seen in breast tissue on a mammogram. Many patterns are benign, while some grouped, irregular, or branching patterns are associated with breast cancer, including ductal carcinoma in situ.

Breast Cancer

A malignant growth arising from breast tissue, most often from cells lining the ducts or lobules. It can be invasive or in situ and may appear as a lump, skin or nipple change, or abnormal imaging; early disease may cause no symptoms.

Breast Cancer And Lymphedema

Swelling caused by impaired lymph drainage after breast-cancer surgery or radiation. It may cause lasting heaviness, tightness, or skin changes in the arm, breast, or chest.

Breast Cancer and Pregnancy

Breast cancer diagnosed during pregnancy. The related term pregnancy-associated breast cancer also includes cases diagnosed within a year after birth or during lactation.

Breast Cancer and Your Genes

Alternate name; see *Breast Cancer Genetics*.

Breast Cancer Genetics

The study of inherited gene changes that affect breast-cancer risk. Important genes include *BRCA1*, *BRCA2*, *PALB2*, *TP53*, *PTEN*, and *CHEK2*.

Breast Cancer Grade

A description of how abnormal breast-cancer cells look under a microscope and how quickly they are likely to grow. Grade is different from cancer stage, which describes the cancer's size and spread.

Breast Cancer in Men

Breast cancer arising in male breast tissue. It is uncommon but may present as a painless lump, nipple retraction, discharge, or skin change; diagnosis uses imaging and biopsy.

Breast Cancer Prevention

Measures intended to reduce the chance of developing breast cancer. They include population-level risk reduction and, for people at substantially increased risk, risk-reducing medicines or surgery; no measure eliminates risk.

Breast Cancer Recurrence

Return of breast cancer after treatment, either near the original site, in nearby lymph nodes, or in distant organs. Persistent symptoms or a lump may have cancerous or noncancerous causes.

Breast Cancer Screening

Testing to find breast cancer before symptoms appear, usually with mammography. Ultrasound or MRI may be added for selected people according to age, breast density, inherited risk, and other factors.

Breast Cancer Staging

Assessment of how far breast cancer has grown or spread, including the tumour's features, nearby lymph nodes, and distant organs. The stage helps estimate outlook and choose treatment.

Breast Carcinoma

A malignant epithelial tumour arising in breast tissue, most often from cells lining the ducts or lobules. Invasive ductal and invasive lobular carcinoma are common forms.

Breast-Conserving Surgery

An operation that removes a breast tumor with a margin of surrounding tissue while preserving most of the breast. It may be used as part of breast-conserving therapy; radiation therapy is often given afterward, depending on the cancer and treatment plan.

Alternate Names:
BCS; Lumpectomy; Partial Mastectomy

Breast-Conserving Therapy

Treatment for selected breast cancers that removes the tumor while preserving most of the breast, usually combining surgery with radiation therapy. For appropriately selected early-stage cancers, survival is similar to mastectomy. The choice depends on the cancer's features and the person's clinical circumstances.

Alternate Names:
BCT; Breast-Conserving Treatment

Breast Cyst

A fluid-filled sac in breast tissue. Simple breast cysts are benign and do not increase breast cancer risk; cysts with internal debris or solid components are distinct findings and may have different significance.

Breast Cysts

Alternate name; see *Breast Cyst*.

Breast Cytology

Examination of individual cells from a breast lump, nipple discharge, or needle sample. It can suggest infection, a harmless change, or cancer, but a core biopsy is often needed to determine the full tissue pattern.

Breast Density

The relative amount of milk-gland and connective tissue compared with fat on a mammogram. Dense breast tissue can hide small cancers and is linked with higher breast-cancer risk.

Breast Development

Growth and maturation of breast tissue, beginning mainly at puberty and changing with hormones, pregnancy, breastfeeding, ageing, and some medicines. Uneven development is common.

Breast Development in Boys

Enlargement or development of breast tissue in a boy, most often gynecomastia caused by a temporary imbalance between estrogen and androgen effects. It may be persistent, painful, asymmetric, or rapidly enlarging.

Breast Duct

A channel that carries milk from milk-producing areas toward the nipple. Blockage, inflammation, or abnormal cells in a duct can cause a lump, pain, or nipple discharge.

Breast Engorgement

Overfilling and swelling of the breasts with milk and extra tissue fluid, usually a few days after birth. Both breasts may feel firm, warm, painful, and make the nipples harder for an infant to grasp.

Breast Enlargement In Males

Alternate name; see *Gynecomastia*.

Breast Examination

Inspection and gentle examination of the breasts, nipples, and nearby lymph nodes to assess lumps, pain, skin or nipple changes, and other findings. It may be followed by imaging or biopsy when needed.

Breast Feed

Alternate name; see *Breastfeeding*.

Breastfeeding

Feeding an infant human milk, either directly from the breast or as expressed milk. Human milk provides nutrition and immune factors. Exclusive

breastfeeding means the infant receives only human milk, apart from specified medicines, vitamins, and rehydration solution. It is distinct from continued breastfeeding alongside complementary foods.

Breastfeeding-Associated Nipple and Skin Changes

Dermatologic and mucosal complications of the nipple-areolar complex occurring during lactation, including painful erythema, skin fissures, milk blisters (blebs), contact dermatitis, Raynaud phenomenon of the nipple, and infectious mastitis or candidiasis.

Alternate Names:
Nipple Trauma in Breastfeeding; Sore Nipples; Nipple Fissures in Lactation

Breastfeeding With Rheumatoid Arthritis

Breastfeeding in a person with rheumatoid arthritis. Disease activity, fatigue, hand function, and medicine compatibility can affect the experience; compatibility varies among antirheumatic medicines.

Breast Finding

Any noticeable breast change, such as a lump, pain, skin change, nipple inversion, or discharge. Causes range from normal variation and benign conditions to breast cancer.

Breast Hamartoma

A benign lump made of an overgrowth of mature breast tissue, including fat, fibrous tissue, and milk-gland tissue. It is also called a fibroadenolipoma. Its appearance on imaging often reflects this mixture of normal tissue types and can vary with the amount of each.

Breast Health

The condition of breast tissue and function, and the field concerned with breast disease, its prevention, and its diagnosis.

Breast Imaging-Reporting And Data System

A standard system for describing mammogram, breast ultrasound, and breast MRI findings. Its numbered categories indicate whether results are normal, benign, probably benign, suspicious, or already known to be cancer and help guide follow-up.

Breast Hematoma

A collection of blood within breast tissue, usually after an injury, operation, or biopsy. It may cause bruising, swelling, pain, or a lump. As it heals, it can change in size or feel and may resemble another breast mass on examination or imaging.

Breast Implant-Associated Anaplastic Large Cell Lymphoma

A rare cancer of immune cells that can develop in the fluid or scar tissue around a breast implant. It is a T-cell lymphoma, not breast carcinoma, and has been linked mainly to textured implants. It may cause lasting swelling, a lump, pain, or hardening around the implant.

Breast Implant Capsular Contracture

Alternate name; see *Capsular Contracture*.

Breast Implant Rupture

A tear or hole in the outer shell of a breast implant. A saline implant usually deflates, while silicone gel may stay within the surrounding scar capsule or leak beyond it; silicone rupture may cause no obvious symptoms. Imaging can help detect a rupture.

Breast Infection

Infection and inflammation of breast tissue, often occurring during breastfeeding. It can cause local pain, warmth, redness, swelling, and fever; worsening symptoms or a pus-filled lump may indicate an abscess.

Breast Infection (Mastitis)

Inflammation or infection of breast tissue, often during breastfeeding but also possible in other settings. Pain, redness, warmth, swelling, fever, and a lump may occur; an abscess can develop if infection persists.

Breast Lift

Surgery that raises and reshapes sagging breast tissue by removing extra skin and, when needed, repositioning the nipple. It changes shape rather than necessarily increasing breast size and can leave scars or alter sensation.

Breast Lipoma

A benign lump made of mature fat cells in the breast. It is often soft, movable, and painless, although its feel can vary. Imaging or a tissue sample may be used to distinguish it from other breast lumps. It is made of mature fat cells rather than breast duct or milk-gland cells.

Breast Lobe

One of the larger sections of a breast's milk-producing gland. It contains smaller lobules and ducts that carry milk toward the nipple.

Breast Lobule

A small milk-producing unit within the breast, made of tiny milk glands and ducts. Lobules enlarge and become more active during pregnancy and breastfeeding.

Breast Lymphedema

Persistent swelling of the breast caused by poor drainage of lymph fluid. It can occur after breast surgery or radiation damages or removes lymph vessels or nodes, and may cause heaviness, tenderness, or skin thickening. The swelling may affect one or both breasts. See also *Lymphedema*.

Breast Lymphoma

A lymphoma that involves breast tissue. It may begin in the breast, called primary breast lymphoma, or spread there from lymphoma elsewhere in the body. It is a cancer of lymphocytes, not the usual breast cancers that begin in ducts or lobules.

Breast Lump

A swelling, mass, or thickened area in breast tissue. Many breast lumps are noncancerous and may result from cysts, fibroadenomas, hormone changes, or injury. Appearance and feel alone cannot reliably show the cause; examination and imaging, and sometimes biopsy, help identify it.

Breast Lump Removal

An operation to remove a breast lump, usually so it can be examined or because it causes symptoms or concern. The need for surgery depends on examination, imaging, biopsy results, and the person's preferences.

Breast Lumps

Alternate name; see *Breast Lump*.

Breast Lumps (Benign)

Noncancerous breast masses such as cysts, fibroadenomas, fat necrosis, or fibrocystic changes. Their features can overlap with those of malignant breast masses.

Breast Milk

Milk made by the breasts after childbirth. It provides energy, nutrients, fluid, and immune substances that support an infant's growth and help protect against some infections.

Breast Milk Expression and Storage

The manual or mechanical extraction of human breast milk and its subsequent storage following strict hygiene, refrigeration, and freezing protocols to preserve bioactive immunoglobulins, micronutrients, and enzymatic properties while preventing microbial contamination.

Alternate Names:
Pumping and Storing Breast Milk; Breast Milk Storage; Milk Expression

Breast Milk Jaundice

Yellowing of the skin and eyes that begins after the first week in an otherwise well, feeding, and growing breastfed infant. It is usually temporary; other causes of newborn jaundice include blood-group incompatibility, infection, and liver disease.

Alternate Names:
Human Milk Jaundice; Late-Onset Neonatal Jaundice

Breast MRI

An imaging test using a strong magnet and radio waves to create detailed pictures of breast tissue. Contrast is often used; MRI is added for selected screening, implant, or diagnostic questions rather than replacing mammography for everyone.

Breast MRI Scan

A scan that uses magnetic fields and radio waves, sometimes with injected contrast, to show breast tissue in detail. It can help assess high cancer risk, an abnormality, implants, or the extent of known cancer.

Breast Neoplasm

An abnormal growth of cells in breast tissue. It may be noncancerous or cancerous; imaging and often a biopsy determine its type, behaviour, and extent.

Breast Pain

Pain or tenderness in one or both breasts. Common causes include hormonal changes, cysts, infection, injury, medicines, or chest-wall problems; it may be focal or occur with a lump.

Alternate Names:
Mastalgia; Mastodynia

Breast Pain (Mastalgia)

Pain or tenderness in one or both breasts. It may be cyclic or related to hormones, injury, cysts, infection, medicines, or chest-wall structures; it can also occur with a mass, skin change, or nipple discharge.

Breast Quadrant

One of four areas used to describe where a finding is located in the breast: upper or lower, and inner or outer. The location helps describe examination and imaging findings.

Breast Rash

A change such as redness, scaling, itching, or irritation of breast skin. Causes include dermatitis, allergy, infection, or rarely inflammatory breast cancer; it may be persistent, one-sided, painful, or involve the nipple.

Breast Reconstruction

Surgery to rebuild the shape and appearance of a breast, most often after mastectomy. It may use an implant, tissue transferred from another part of the body, or both, and may include reconstruction of the nipple and areola. Reconstruction can be immediate or delayed and may involve several procedures.

Breast Reduction

Surgery that removes breast tissue, fat, and skin to reduce breast size and relieve symptoms such as back, neck, or shoulder pain. Possible effects include scars, altered sensation, breastfeeding difficulty, and uneven shape.

Breast Screening

Testing people without breast symptoms to find breast cancer early, most commonly with mammography. Screening schedules vary with local guidelines, personal risk, family history, and previous findings.

Breast Self-Examination

Deliberate, regular inspection and feeling of the breasts to look for changes. Routine breast self-examination has not been shown to reduce breast-cancer deaths and can lead to unnecessary investigations.

Breast Skin And Nipple Changes

Changes such as dimpling, redness, scaling, inversion, crusting, or discharge may result from benign conditions, infection, hormonal changes, or cancer. They may be persistent, one-sided, or bloody.

Breast Surgeon

A surgeon who diagnoses and treats breast conditions, including benign disease, breast cancer, reconstruction, and operations that reduce cancer risk.

Breast Surgery

An operation on the breast to remove or examine a lump, treat cancer, reduce size, reconstruct shape, or address another condition. The type of surgery depends on the diagnosis, extent of disease, and person's goals.

Breast Ultrasound

Imaging that uses sound waves to examine breast tissue. It helps assess a lump, distinguish fluid from solid tissue, investigate a mammogram finding, guide a biopsy, and evaluate selected implants or dense breasts.

Breath

Air moved into and out of the lungs. Its smell, depth, rate, pattern, and oxygen or carbon-dioxide content can provide clues about breathing, infection, metabolism, or other health problems.

Breath Alcohol Test

A test measuring alcohol in exhaled air to estimate alcohol concentration in the blood. Results depend on timing, the device, sampling, and health factors and may be used in clinical or legal settings.

Breathalyzer

A device that estimates alcohol concentration in the blood by measuring alcohol in exhaled air. Results can be affected by timing, device accuracy, recent drinking, mouth alcohol, and sampling conditions.

Breath Analysis

Testing exhaled air for specific substances or gases. Examples include breath-alcohol tests, urea breath tests for *Helicobacter pylori*, exhaled nitric oxide tests for airway inflammation, and hydrogen or methane tests for carbohydrate malabsorption or suspected small-intestinal bacterial overgrowth.

Breath Focus

A mindfulness or relaxation exercise that directs attention to the sensations of breathing. It is used in meditation and other practices that train attention or relaxation.

Alternate Names:
Breath-Focused Meditation; Breathing-Focused Mindfulness

Breath-Holding Spell

A benign, involuntary paroxysmal nonepileptic phenomenon occurring in young children (typically between 6 months and 6 years of age), precipitated by emotional distress, anger, or minor physical pain. The episode begins with vigorous crying followed by prolonged expiration, apnea, and brief loss of consciousness, occasionally accompanied by generalized hypertonia or clonic jerks. Two distinct forms are recognized: cyanotic spells (most common, driven by rapid apnea and hypocapnia) and pallid spells (mediated by severe vagal bradycardia or transient asystole). Spontaneous recovery is rapid and complete; coexisting iron-deficiency anemia is frequent and its correction reduces spell frequency.

Breath-Holding Spells

Plural form; see *Breath-Holding Spell*.

Breathing

Movement of air into and out of the lungs. It brings oxygen into the body and removes carbon dioxide through coordinated activity of the brain, nerves, muscles, and airways.

Breathing Difficulty

Alternate name; see *Dyspnea*.

Breathing Difficulty First Aid

Immediate supportive care intended to maintain breathing and circulation during acute respiratory distress before definitive treatment.

Alternate Names:
First Aid for Dyspnea; Emergency Respiratory Support; Respiratory Distress Management

Breathing Exercises

Deliberate changes in breathing pattern used to support relaxation, lung expansion, airway clearance, breath control, or rehabilitation.

Breathlessness

Alternate name; see *Dyspnea*.

Breath Odor

An unpleasant smell from the mouth or exhaled air. Common causes include dental or gum disease, dry mouth, tobacco, food, medicines, and infection; per-

sistent odor may be associated with an underlying oral or systemic condition.

Breath Sounds

Sounds made as air moves through the airways and lungs, heard with a stethoscope. Reduced, absent, or unusual sounds can provide clues about mucus, narrowing, fluid, collapse, or other lung problems.

Breath Stacking

A breathing technique in which several small breaths are taken without fully exhaling, increasing the amount of air in the lungs. It can help produce a stronger cough in people with weak breathing muscles.

Breath Test

Analysis of exhaled air to detect a substance made by the body or by microorganisms. Examples include tests for Helicobacter pylori and tests measuring hydrogen or methane after a sugar drink to assess digestion and absorption.

Breech Baby

A fetus positioned in the womb with the buttocks or feet pointing downward toward the birth canal instead of the head. Most babies turn into a head-down (vertex) position before late pregnancy, but those remaining breech near term may be delivered by cesarean section or planned vaginal breech birth, or turned via external cephalic version.

Alternate Names:
Breech fetus; Breech presentation.

Breech Birth

Birth in which the baby is positioned bottom or feet first rather than head first. The safest delivery plan depends on the exact position, pregnancy stage, baby and parent factors, and the team's experience.

Breech Delivery

Birth when the fetus presents buttocks or feet first rather than head first. Breech presentations include frank, complete, and footling types.

Breech Presentation

A fetal position in which the buttocks or feet point toward the birth canal. Types include frank, complete, and footling breech; risks include cord prolapse, difficulty delivering the head, and birth injury.

Alternate Names:
Breech position; Malpresentation.

Bregma

The point on the skull where the main seam between the frontal and parietal bones meets the seam between the two parietal bones. In infants it lies beneath the soft spot at the front of the skull.

Bremsstrahlung

Radiation produced when fast electrons slow down or change direction near matter. It is relevant to some imaging and radiation treatments and requires appropriate shielding and safety controls.

Brenner Tumor

A rare ovarian growth made of cells resembling those lining the urinary tract. Most are small, one-sided, noncancerous, and found incidentally, but uncommon borderline or cancerous forms also occur.

Brenner Tumour

A usually noncancerous ovarian growth whose cells resemble those lining the urinary tract. Rare borderline and cancerous forms occur and are distinguished by tissue examination.

Breslau Bacillus

An older name for Salmonella Typhimurium, a bacterium that can cause foodborne gastroenteritis with diarrhoea, abdominal cramps, fever, and vomiting.

Breslow Thickness

The depth, measured in millimetres, to which a melanoma has grown into the skin. It is an important part of staging and helps estimate the risk of spread and guide treatment.

Bretylium Tosylate

An older medicine that can suppress certain danger-

ous abnormal heart rhythms, especially ventricular fibrillation. It is now rarely used because of limited availability, side effects, and newer treatments.

Brevibacillus

A group of spore-forming bacteria found in soil, water, and food. Human infection is uncommon but can occur opportunistically, especially in people with weakened immunity or medical devices.

Brevibacterium

A group of bacteria found on skin, in soil, and in food. They commonly contribute to body or cheese odour; rare species can cause opportunistic infection, particularly in people with serious illness or devices.

Brevibacterium Casei

A species of Brevibacterium found in the environment and occasionally on people. It rarely causes bloodstream or device-related infection, usually in a person with major underlying illness or an indwelling device.

Brevundimonas

A group of environmental water-associated bacteria that rarely cause human disease. Opportunistic infections, including bloodstream or wound infection, are more likely in people with weakened immunity or medical devices.

Brevundimonas Diminuta

An environmental water-associated bacterium that rarely causes opportunistic human infection. Reported illnesses include bloodstream, wound, or device-related infection, mainly in people with serious underlying disease.

Brevundimonas Vesicularis

An environmental bacterium that rarely causes human infection. When it is isolated from a clinical sample, symptoms, specimen quality, and other results determine whether it represents true disease or contamination.

Bricklayer's Disease

An older occupational term for lung disease caused by breathing dust during masonry work, especially silica-containing dust. Long-term exposure can cause silicosis, which scars the lungs and impairs breathing.

Bridge To Transplant

Temporary treatment or mechanical support that keeps a person with advanced heart failure alive and stable until a heart transplant can be performed. The device, timing, and risks depend on heart function and overall health.

Bridge Work

A fixed dental replacement for one or more missing teeth. Artificial teeth are attached to prepared neighbouring teeth or implants, restoring some chewing function and appearance.

Brief Psychotic Disorder

A sudden episode of delusions, hallucinations, severely disorganized speech, or markedly disorganized behavior lasting at least one day but less than one month, followed by a return toward usual functioning.

Alternate Names:
Brief Reactive Psychosis; Acute Transient Psychosis

Brief Resolved Unexplained Event

A sudden, brief episode in an infant younger than one year that has fully resolved and remains unexplained after an appropriate history and examination. It involves a change in breathing, colour, muscle tone, or responsiveness. BRUE replaced the broader, less specific term apparent life-threatening event (ALTE).

Alternate Names:
BRUE

Brill's Disease

Recurrence of epidemic typhus years after the first infection because dormant Rickettsia prowazekii becomes active again. It is usually milder than the original illness but can still be spread by body lice.

Brill-Zinsser Disease

Recurrent epidemic typhus caused by reactivation of dormant Rickettsia prowazekii years after the original infection. The illness is usually milder but can be transmitted by body lice.

Brimonidine Tartrate

A medicine that reduces certain nerve signals and blood-vessel activity. Eye drops lower pressure inside the eye, and skin preparations can reduce some facial redness; side effects and interactions are possible.

Brine Bath

Bathing in salty water, sometimes used for comfort or certain skin conditions. It does not treat every skin problem, and hot water or salt can worsen irritation, dry skin, wounds, or some medical conditions.

Brittle Asthma

An uncommon, older term for severe asthma marked by sudden, unpredictable attacks or major variation in airflow despite treatment. It is not a consistently used modern asthma classification.

Brittle Bone Disease

An inherited disorder, usually osteogenesis imperfecta, in which bones break easily. It can also cause short stature, loose joints, blue-gray eye whites, hearing loss, dental problems, or other skeletal changes.

Brittle Nail Syndrome

A pattern of nails that split, peel, crack, or break easily, often because of repeated wetting and drying, detergents, trauma, ageing, or inflammatory nail disease. Iron deficiency, thyroid disease, fungal infection, and inherited disorders can contribute; changes may be persistent, painful, or widespread.

Brivudine

An antiviral medicine used in some countries for shingles. It is not used with fluoropyrimidine cancer medicines or certain related treatments because the interaction can be fatal.

Broad-Based Gait

A walking pattern in which the feet are set farther apart than usual, often reflecting impaired balance. It may occur with cerebellar ataxia or severe loss of lower-limb proprioception.

Broad Casts

Wide urinary casts formed in dilated kidney tubules, often when urine flow is slow or kidney tissue is damaged. Waxy broad casts are associated with advanced chronic kidney disease, but broad casts alone do not establish a diagnosis or disease stage.

Alternate Names:
Renal Failure Casts; Wide Casts

Broad-Complex Tachycardia

A fast heart rhythm with wide QRS complexes on an electrocardiogram, usually at least 120 milliseconds. It may arise in the ventricles or from an upper-chamber rhythm conducted abnormally, including through an accessory pathway.

Alternate Names:
Wide-Complex Tachycardia

Broad Ligament

A sheet of tissue extending from the sides of the uterus to the pelvic walls. It helps support the uterus, fallopian tubes, and ovaries and contains blood vessels, nerves, and connective tissue.

Broad Nasal Bridge

An unusually wide upper part of the nose between the eyes. It may be a normal family feature or part of a condition present from birth or an inherited syndrome.

Broca Aphasia

A language disorder in which speech is slow, effortful, and difficult to produce, while understanding may be relatively preserved. It usually follows damage to the dominant frontal language area, often from a stroke.

Broca's Aphasia

A nonfluent language disorder caused by damage

to the dominant frontal language region. Speech is effortful and limited, while understanding may be better preserved than speaking or repeating words.

Broca's Area

A region in the dominant frontal lobe that helps plan and produce spoken language. Damage can cause slow, effortful speech and difficulty forming words, while understanding may be relatively preserved.

Brodie Abscess

A chronic, well-circumscribed subacute pyogenic bone abscess that represents a localized form of osteomyelitis. It characteristically develops in the metaphysis of long bones (most frequently the proximal or distal tibia) in children and young adults, presenting as a lytic bone lesion with a surrounding ring of sclerotic bone on radiography.

Brodie's Abscess

Alternate name; see *Brodie Abscess*.

Brodmann Area

A region of the cerebral cortex anatomically defined and numbered (1 through 52) based on its distinct cellular architecture (cytoarchitectonics), with specific areas corresponding to distinct functional neurological roles (such as area 4 for primary motor cortex).

Brody Disease

A rare inherited muscle disorder causing painless stiffness and slow muscle relaxation after strenuous or repeated exercise. It often begins in childhood and may affect the face, eyelids, or hands; symptoms can resemble myotonia but arise from a different muscle problem.

Alternate Names:
Brody Myopathy; SERCA1-Related Muscle Disease

Broken Ankle

A break in one or more bones forming the ankle joint. It usually causes pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty bearing weight; deformity, an open wound, numbness, or poor circulation may indicate associated injury.

Broken Arm

A break in one or more arm bones, usually causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or loss of function. An open injury, severe deformity, numbness, or reduced circulation may indicate associated tissue or nerve injury.

Broken Blood Vessel in Eye

Alternate name; see *Subconjunctival Hemorrhage*.

Broken Bone

Alternate name; see *Bone Fracture*.

Broken Clavicle

Alternate name; see *Broken Collarbone*.

Broken Collarbone

A break in the clavicle, usually after a fall or direct blow. It causes pain, swelling, tenderness, and reduced shoulder movement; numbness, breathing difficulty, or a skin-threatening deformity may indicate associated injury.

Broken Finger

A fracture of one or more finger bones, usually caused by a blow, crush, or twist. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or reduced movement may occur.

Alternate Names:
Finger Fracture

Broken Foot

A break in one or more foot bones after a fall, blow, twist, or repeated stress. Pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty walking are common; deformity, an open wound, or numbness may indicate associated injury.

Broken Hand

A fracture of one or more hand bones, including metacarpals or finger bones. It can cause pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or reduced movement.

Broken Heart Syndrome

Temporary weakening of the heart muscle, often

after severe emotional or physical stress. It can resemble a heart attack with chest pain or breathlessness, but the coronary arteries usually have no blocking clot.

Broken Hip

Alternate name; see *Hip Fracture*.

Broken Leg

A break in one or more leg bones, usually causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or inability to bear weight. An open injury, numbness, or loss of circulation may indicate associated injury.

Broken Little Finger

Alternate name; see *Broken Finger*.

Broken Nose

A break in one or more nasal bones that may cause pain, swelling, bruising, bleeding, deformity, or difficulty breathing through the nose. Persistent bleeding, clear fluid leakage, or severe deformity may indicate associated injury.

Broken Or Dislocated Jaw

A break or displacement of the jaw that can cause pain, swelling, an altered bite, limited movement, loose teeth, or difficulty speaking, swallowing, or breathing.

Broken Or Knocked Out Tooth

A tooth damaged or completely forced out of its socket by injury. A completely displaced tooth is called an avulsed tooth; fractures may involve the enamel, dentine, pulp, or root.

Broken Ribs

Breaks in one or more ribs, usually causing local chest pain that worsens with breathing, coughing, or movement. Severe breathing difficulty, increasing pain, coughing blood, or major trauma may indicate associated chest injury.

Broken Toe

A break in a toe bone, usually after a direct blow or crush. Pain, swelling, bruising, and tenderness are common; deformity, an open wound, numbness, or poor circulation may indicate associated injury.

Alternate Names:
Toe Fracture; Phalanx Fracture

Broken Wrist

A break in one or more bones near the wrist, often causing pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, or reduced hand function. Numbness, pale or cold fingers, an open wound, or severe deformity may indicate associated injury.

Bromelain

A mixture of enzymes from pineapple. It is sold as a supplement and studied for pain and inflammation, but evidence and product strength vary; it can cause allergy, stomach upset, or interactions with medicines.

Bromhexine

A medicine that thins sticky mucus in the airways so it may be coughed up more easily. It can cause stomach upset or rash and rarely causes a serious skin reaction.

Bromhidrosis

Unusually strong or unpleasant body odour produced when skin microorganisms break down apocrine or eccrine sweat and other secretions. It commonly affects the armpits, feet, or groin and may be associated with hyperhidrosis, occlusion, infection, or retained skin debris.

Bromides

Salts or compounds containing bromide. Excessive or prolonged exposure can cause bromism, with symptoms affecting the nervous system, mood, digestion, or skin.

Bromine

A reactive chemical used in industry and some flame-resistant materials. Bromine and many bromine compounds can irritate or burn tissue, while substantial exposure can cause poisoning affecting several organs.

Bromism

Poisoning caused by prolonged or excessive exposure to bromide compounds. It may cause confusion, drowsiness, poor coordination, mood or behaviour changes, digestive symptoms, acne-like eruptions, or other neurologic problems.

Bromobenzenes

Industrial chemicals made by attaching one or more bromine atoms to benzene. Exposure can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways or cause other toxic effects, depending on the specific compound and amount.

Bromocriptine

A dopamine-receptor agonist that lowers prolactin release and can also reduce growth-hormone release. It is used to treat hyperprolactinemia, acromegaly, and Parkinson disease; one formulation is also used for type 2 diabetes. Side effects can include nausea, dizziness, and low blood pressure.

Bromoderma

An inflammatory skin eruption linked to bromine or bromide exposure. It may appear as acne-like, pustular, or other irritated lesions and usually improves when the source is identified and removed.

Bromodosis

Unpleasant foot odour caused when microorganisms break down sweat, moisture, and skin debris. It may occur with excessive sweating, skin maceration, or fungal or bacterial infection.

Bromophos

An organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can overstimulate nerves and cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, breathing difficulty, weakness, seizures, or collapse.

Brompheniramine Overdose

Poisoning from taking too much brompheniramine, an antihistamine. It may cause severe sleepiness or agitation, confusion, dry mouth, rapid heartbeat, seizures, or dangerous heart rhythms.

Bromthymol Blue

A chemical indicator that changes colour according to acidity and alkalinity. It is used in laboratories and is not a medicine or treatment.

Bronchi

The two main airways carrying air from the windpipe into the lungs. Each divides into smaller branches; the right main bronchus is wider and more vertical, so inhaled objects are more likely to enter it.

Bronchial

Relating to the bronchi, the large airways branching from the windpipe. Bronchial disease may cause cough, wheezing, mucus production, narrowing, or reduced airflow.

Bronchial Artery

An artery from the body's general circulation that supplies the walls of the bronchi and supporting lung tissues. It differs from the pulmonary arteries, which carry blood to the lungs for oxygen exchange.

Bronchial Artery Embolization

A catheter procedure that blocks bleeding arteries supplying the airways, usually for severe or repeated hemoptysis. A rare serious complication is spinal-cord ischemia from blockage of an artery supplying the spinal cord.

Alternate Names:
BAE; Bronchial Embolization; Embolization of Bronchial Arteries

Bronchial Asthma

See *Asthma*.

Bronchial Biopsy

Removal of a small tissue sample from an airway during bronchoscopy. Laboratory examination can investigate inflammation, infection, abnormal growths, or cancer; bleeding and breathing complications are possible.

Bronchial Breath Sounds

Harsh, high-pitched, hollow breath sounds with a prolonged expiratory phase and an audible pause between inspiration and expiration. Normally auscultated over the trachea and main bronchi, their presence over peripheral lung fields indicates abnormal transmission through consolidated lung tissue, as in lobar pneumonia.

Bronchial Carcinoid

A usually slow-growing neuroendocrine tumour arising in an airway. Typical carcinoids are generally less aggressive than atypical carcinoids, but either can block an airway, cause coughing or bleeding, or spread to other sites.

Bronchial Carcinoma

See *Lung Cancer*.

Bronchial Circulation

The systemic arterial blood supply providing oxygenated blood and nutrients to the conducting airways, supporting stroma, and visceral pleura of the lungs, arising from bronchial arteries branching off the thoracic aorta or intercostal arteries.

Bronchial Fistula

An abnormal passage between an airway and another structure, such as the space around the lung, food pipe, or skin. It can cause persistent air leakage, coughing, infection, or breathing failure.

Bronchial Hemorrhage

Bleeding from airway blood vessels, usually seen as coughing up blood. Heavy bleeding can block the airway or cause breathing failure.

Bronchial Hyperresponsiveness

An increased tendency of the airways to narrow in response to stimuli, measured with tests such as a methacholine challenge. It is common in asthma but is not specific to asthma and can occur in other airway diseases, including chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

Alternate Names:
Airway Hyperreactivity

Bronchial Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of an airway by mucus, an inhaled object, a tumour, swelling, or pressure from outside. It can reduce airflow and lead to lung collapse, repeated infection, wheezing, or breathlessness.

Bronchial Stenosis

Narrowing of an airway caused by scarring, inflammation, infection, injury, a tumour, or a previous procedure. It can cause localised wheezing, breathlessness, repeated infection, or poor mucus clearance.

Bronchial Stricture

Abnormal narrowing of an airway caused by scarring, inflammation, infection, a tumour, or previous instrumentation. It may produce localised wheezing, cough, repeated infection, or collapse of the lung beyond the narrowing.

Bronchial Tree

The branching network of airways from the windpipe through the main, lobar, and smaller bronchi and bronchioles toward the air sacs. It conducts and distributes air throughout the lungs.

Bronchial Tubes

The two main bronchi and their branches, which carry air from the windpipe into the lungs and divide into progressively smaller airways.

Alternate Names:
Bronchi; Bronchial Tree When Referring to the Branching Airway System

Bronchial Vein

A vein that drains blood from the walls of the larger airways and nearby lung tissue. It empties partly into veins returning blood to the heart and partly into pulmonary veins.

Bronchiectasis

A long-term condition in which parts of the airways

become permanently widened and damaged. The airways may not clear mucus well, so mucus builds up and can lead to a persistent cough, repeated chest infections, and breathlessness. Causes include severe or repeated infections, other lung or immune conditions, and airway blockage; sometimes the cause is unknown. Some people also cough up blood.

Bronchiole

A small airway of the lower respiratory tract (< 1 mm in diameter) that branches from segmental bronchi and is characterized histologically by the absence of cartilage and submucosal glands in its wall. Bronchioles are lined by ciliated cuboidal-to-columnar epithelium and secretoglobin-secreting club cells, surrounded by a circumferential layer of smooth muscle responsive to autonomic control. They subdivide into terminal bronchioles and respiratory bronchioles, which open into alveolar ducts.

Bronchiolectasis

Permanent widening of the small airways, usually caused by chronic inflammation, infection, or blockage. It may occur with bronchiectasis and contribute to poor mucus clearance and repeated infection.

Bronchioles

Plural form; see *Bronchiole*.

Bronchiolitis

Inflammation and blockage of the smallest airways, usually from a viral infection in infants and young children. It can cause cough, wheezing, fast breathing, chest retractions, poor feeding, and low oxygen.

Bronchiolitis Obliterans

A rare disease in which inflammation and scarring permanently narrow or close the smallest airways. It can follow severe infection, inhaled injury, autoimmune disease, or transplantation and causes persistent cough and breathlessness.

Bronchitis

Inflammation of the larger airways. Acute bronchitis is usually caused by a virus and causes cough, with or without mucus, while chronic bronchitis means mucus-producing cough for at least three months in two successive years.

Bronchoalveolar Lavage

A bronchoscopy procedure in which sterile fluid is put into a small lung area and then collected. The sample can be tested for infection, inflammation, abnormal cells, or other lung disease.

Bronchocele

Abnormal widening of a bronchus filled with mucus, usually because an airway is blocked or developed abnormally. It may cause cough, repeated infection, or no symptoms and is assessed with imaging.

Bronchocentric Granulomatosis

A rare, non-necrotizing or necrotizing granulomatous inflammatory disorder centered primarily on conducting bronchi and bronchioles, frequently associated with tissue eosinophilia and severe asthma or allergic bronchopulmonary aspergillosis.

Bronchoconstriction

Narrowing of the bronchi caused by contraction of the smooth muscle in their walls. It increases resistance to airflow and commonly occurs in asthma or after exposure to certain allergens, irritants, or medicines. Airway swelling and mucus can also narrow the airways but are distinct mechanisms.

Bronchoconstrictor Agents

Substances that narrow the airways by tightening airway muscle or causing inflammation. Examples include histamine, leukotrienes, irritant gases, and some medicines.

Bronchodilator

A medicine that relaxes muscles around the airways, widening them and making breathing easier. It can relieve or prevent wheezing and breathlessness in asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, and other conditions with narrowed airways.

Alternate Names:
Bronchodilators

Bronchodilator Response

The change in airflow measured by spirometry after a bronchodilator is given. Improvement can support variable airway narrowing, but no response does not exclude asthma and a response does not prove one specific disease.

Bronchodilator Reversibility

Improvement in measured airflow after an inhaled bronchodilator. It can support variable airway narrowing, but one result alone cannot confirm or exclude asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

Bronchoesophageal Fistula

An abnormal connection between an airway and the food pipe. It may be present from birth or develop from cancer, infection, injury, or treatment and can cause coughing during swallowing, repeated pneumonia, or breathing problems.

Bronchogenic Carcinoma

See *Lung Cancer*.

Bronchogenic Cyst

A birth-related fluid-filled cyst that develops from early airway or food-pipe tissue, often near the windpipe or central chest. It may cause no symptoms or press on nearby structures.

Bronchomalacia

Weakness of an airway wall that allows it to collapse too much, especially during breathing out. It may cause noisy breathing, cough, breathlessness, repeated infections, or difficulty clearing mucus.

Bronchophony

An examination finding in which spoken sounds are heard unusually clearly through a stethoscope over part of the lung. It can occur when lung tissue is solidified by infection or another process but is not diagnostic by itself.

Bronchopleural Fistula

An abnormal connection between an airway and the space around the lung, often after lung surgery or severe infection. It can cause a persistent air leak, breathlessness, infection, or air under the skin.

Bronchopneumonia

Infection causing scattered areas of inflammation and consolidation around the small airways in one or more lung lobes. It may cause fever, cough, mucus, chest pain, fast breathing, and low oxygen.

Bronchoprovocation Test

A breathing test used to look for airways that narrow too easily, often when asthma is suspected but routine spirometry is normal. A substance such as methacholine is inhaled in increasing amounts while breathing is measured. A significant fall in airflow supports airway sensitivity, but does not by itself prove asthma.

Alternate Names:
Methacholine Challenge Test; Bronchial Provocation Test

Bronchopulmonary Dysplasia

A chronic lung disease affecting some infants born very preterm, often after neonatal respiratory distress syndrome. Immature lung development and injury associated with inflammation, infection, oxygen, or breathing support contribute. It may cause prolonged need for oxygen or other respiratory support, wheezing, or pulmonary hypertension.

Bronchopulmonary Segments

Natural sections of a lung lobe, each supplied by its own airway branch and pulmonary artery branch. Their separation helps doctors describe disease and allows some operations to remove only an affected segment.

Bronchoscope

A thin tube with a light and camera used to examine the windpipe and airways. Instruments passed through it can remove an object or collect tissue, fluid, or mucus for testing.

Bronchoscopic Culture

Laboratory testing of fluid or tissue collected during

bronchoscopy to look for bacteria, fungi, or mycobacteria when sputum or other ordinary samples are not sufficient.

Bronchoscopy

Examination of the windpipe and airways with a flexible or rigid camera tube. It can investigate persistent cough, infection, bleeding, or a lung mass and can remove foreign material or collect samples; sedation or anaesthesia is used.

Bronchospasm

Sudden tightening of airway muscles that narrows the breathing passages. It can cause wheezing, cough, chest tightness, and difficulty breathing and may be triggered by asthma, allergy, infection, irritants, or airway procedures.

Bronchostenosis

Narrowing of a bronchus that restricts airflow. Causes include scarring, inflammation, infection, a tumour, an inhaled object, pressure from outside, or a previous procedure and may cause wheezing or repeated infection.

Bronchus

One of the two main branches of the windpipe that carries air into a lung. Each divides into smaller branches; the right main bronchus is wider and more vertical, making it a more common site for inhaled objects to lodge.

Bronchus Disease

Any condition affecting one or more bronchi, the air passages leading into the lungs. Infection, asthma, chronic inflammation, blockage, scarring, or a tumour may reduce airflow and cause cough, wheezing, or repeated infection.

Bronchus Neoplasm

An abnormal growth arising in a bronchus. It may be noncancerous or cancerous; imaging, bronchoscopy, and tissue testing help determine its type, extent, and treatment.

Brooke Disease

A rare inherited skin disorder involving abnormal thickening of the outer skin or hair follicles. Because the eponym has been used for more than one condition, the original source and clinical features are checked.

Brooke-Spiegler Syndrome

An inherited disorder causing multiple usually noncancerous skin tumours, often on the head and neck. It is commonly linked to changes in the CYLD gene and may include cylindromas, spiradenomas, or trichoepitheliomas.

Broselow Tape

A colour-coded tape that estimates a child's weight from body length during an emergency and is used to identify approximate medicine doses, fluid amounts, equipment sizes, and defibrillator settings.

Alternate Names:
Broselow Pediatric Emergency Tape; Pediatric Length-Based Resuscitation Tape

Brown Adipose Tissue

A specialized type of adipose tissue characterized by multilocular lipid droplets, abundant mitochondria, and high levels of uncoupling protein 1 (UCP1, thermogenin), specialized for non-shivering thermogenesis in newborns and hibernating mammals.

Alternate Names:
Brown Fat; BAT

Brown Fat

A type of body fat containing many energy-producing structures that generate heat. It is especially important for keeping newborns warm and can also be activated by cold in adults.

Brown Lung Disease

Alternate name; see *Byssinosis*.

Brown Recluse Spider

A venomous spider whose bite may initially be mild but can later cause painful skin damage, blistering, or tissue death. Rarely, its venom causes fever, red-

cell destruction, kidney injury, or other systemic illness.

Brown Recluse Spider Bite

Alternate name; see *Spider Bites*.

Brown Sequard Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Brown-Sequard Syndrome*.

Brown-Sequard Syndrome

A rare neurological condition caused by damage to one half (one side) of the spinal cord, often resulting from a puncture wound, spinal injury, tumor, or blood flow blockage. Because nerve pathways cross to opposite sides of the body at different points, the condition creates a distinct pattern of symptoms: loss of muscle movement and fine touch sensation on the same side of the body as the injury, combined with loss of pain and temperature sensation on the opposite side.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Cord Hemisection; Brown-Séquard Syndrome

Brown Stain

A brown discoloration of the teeth caused by pigments from food, drinks, tobacco, or bacteria. Surface stains differ from intrinsic discoloration caused by decay, enamel defects, or other changes within the tooth.

Brown Syndrome

Limited ability to lift the eye when it is turned inward, because the superior oblique tendon cannot glide freely through its pulley, the trochlea. The affected eye appears lower than the other in that gaze direction and double vision may occur. It can be present at birth or develop from inflammation, injury, sinus disease or surgery, or rheumatic disease such as rheumatoid arthritis. Some cases resolve spontaneously.

Brown Teeth

Brown discolouration of teeth caused by surface stains, decay, enamel defects, excess fluoride, medicines, injury, or other conditions. A dental examination identifies the cause and appropriate treatment.

Brow Presentation

A fetal position in which the forehead leads because the head is partly extended. The head presents a wide diameter, so persistent brow presentation at term may prevent vaginal birth.

Brucella

A group of bacteria that usually infect animals but can infect people through unpasteurised dairy products, inhalation, or contact with infected animals or tissues. Human infection causes brucellosis.

Brucella Abortus

A Brucella species mainly associated with cattle. It can infect people exposed to infected animals, tissues, or unpasteurised dairy products and cause prolonged fever and other brucellosis symptoms.

Brucella Canis

A Brucella species associated with dogs. It rarely infects people after contact with infected dogs or reproductive material and may cause prolonged fever or other brucellosis symptoms.

Brucellaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Brucella and related animal-associated species. Some members cause brucellosis, an infection that can pass from animals to people.

Brucella Melitensis

A Brucella species mainly associated with goats and sheep and a frequent cause of severe human brucellosis, usually acquired through unpasteurised dairy products or infected animals.

Brucella Suis

A Brucella species associated with pigs and some wildlife. It can infect people through animal contact or contaminated food and may cause prolonged illness or infection in bones and organs.

Brucellosis

An infection caused by Brucella bacteria, usually acquired from infected animals, animal tissues, or unpasteurised dairy products. It may cause prolonged fever, sweats, tiredness, headache, and muscle or joint pain.

Bruce Protocol

A graded treadmill test in which speed and slope increase at set stages. It assesses exercise capacity, symptoms, heart-rate and blood-pressure responses, and signs of reduced blood flow to the heart.

Bruch's Membrane

A thin supporting layer between the retina and the blood-rich tissue behind it. It helps nourish and maintain the retina and can become damaged in ageing, diabetes, and some retinal diseases.

Bruck's Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder combining fragile bones with joint stiffness or fixed contractures present from birth. It results from changes affecting connective tissue and may cause repeated fractures and limited movement.

Brudzinski Sign

Involuntary bending of the hips and knees when the neck is gently bent forward. It can occur with irritation of the tissues around the brain and spinal cord, including meningitis, but does not confirm the diagnosis.

Brugada ECG Pattern Type 1

A characteristic ECG pattern with raised ST segments and an inverted T wave in certain right-sided chest leads. It may occur with Brugada syndrome, fever, medicines, or other conditions. The ECG pattern alone does not establish the inherited syndrome or predict the same risk in every person.

Alternate Names:
Type 1 Brugada Pattern; Coved ST Elevation Pattern

Brugada Phenocopy

A temporary ECG pattern resembling Brugada syndrome but caused by another problem, such as fever, abnormal blood salts, reduced heart blood flow, medicines, or poisoning. The pattern resolves when the cause is corrected and is distinguished from inherited disease.

Alternate Names:
Acquired Brugada Pattern; BrP

Brugada Syndrome

A rare, inherited heart rhythm disorder caused by abnormal electrical channels in heart muscle cells, even though the physical structure of the heart is completely normal. It can trigger dangerously fast, irregular heartbeats in the lower chambers (ventricles), which can cause fainting, seizures, or sudden cardiac arrest, often during rest or sleep, and sometimes triggered by high fever. It is diagnosed by a characteristic electrical pattern seen on an electrocardiogram (ECG).

Brugia

A group of parasitic worms spread by mosquitoes that can cause lymphatic filariasis. The infection may damage lymph vessels and lead to recurrent fever, swelling, or long-term enlargement of limbs or genital tissues.

Bruise

Extravasation of blood into the subcutaneous tissue or dermis beneath intact skin (contusion or ecchymosis), resulting from mechanical disruption of small capillaries by blunt force. Hemoglobin undergoes enzymatic degradation from red-blue heme to green biliverdin, yellow-brown bilirubin, and golden-brown hemosiderin as it resolves. Spontaneous, widespread, or disproportionate bruising suggests underlying coagulopathy, thrombocytopenia, vascular fragility, or medication effect.

Alternate Names:
Contusion; Ecchymosis

Bruises

Plural form; see *Bruise*.

Bruising

Purplish, blue, green, or yellow skin discolouration caused by blood leaking into tissue, usually after injury. Colour changes as the blood is broken down; widespread or unexplained bruising may be associated with medicines, blood disorders, or other illness.

Bruit

An abnormal whooshing sound heard over a blood vessel, usually with a stethoscope, caused by turbulent blood flow. It may suggest narrowing but does not by itself establish the cause or severity.

Brunner Gland

Singular form; see *Brunner Glands*.

Brunner Glands

Compound branched tubuloalveolar submucosal glands located exclusively in the duodenum, concentrated primarily in the bulb and proximal descending portions. They secrete an alkaline, bicarbonate-rich, mucin-containing fluid that protects the duodenal mucosa from gastric acid erosion and optimizes luminal pH for pancreatic digestive enzymes.

Alternate Names:
Duodenal Submucosal Glands; Brunner's Glands

Brunner's Gland

Alternate name; see *Brunner Glands*.

Brunner's Glands

Alternate name; see *Brunner Glands*.

Bruns Syndrome

Episodic, sudden attacks of severe headache, vomiting, vertigo, and syncope triggered by abrupt neck movements, caused by transient obstruction of cerebrospinal fluid flow in the fourth ventricle by a mobile mass, such as a cysticercal cyst or ependymoma.

Brush Burns

Superficial friction injuries caused by scraping skin against a rough surface. They cause pain, redness, and grazes; deep, extensive, or infected injuries can involve tissue damage or infection.

Brushfield's Spots

Small gray or white spots arranged around the coloured part of the eye. They are common in people with Down syndrome but can also occur in healthy people and usually do not affect vision.

Bruton Agammaglobulinemia

An X-linked primary immunodeficiency disorder caused by mutations in the Bruton tyrosine kinase (*BTK*) gene, resulting in failure of pre-B cells to differentiate into mature B lymphocytes, profound pan-hypogammaglobulinemia, and recurrent pyogenic bacterial infections beginning after maternal antibodies wane.

Alternate Names:
X-Linked Agammaglobulinemia; XLA

Bruxism

Repeated clenching or grinding of the teeth, often during sleep. It can wear down or crack teeth and cause pain in the jaw, face, or ear, or cause headaches. It may be linked to sleep problems, stress, or some medicines.

Alternate Names:
Teeth Grinding; Tooth Clenching

Bryant's Traction

An older treatment in which an infant's or young child's legs are gently elevated with traction to treat selected hip or thigh conditions. It is rarely used because of complications including nerve injury and impaired circulation.

B-Type Natriuretic Peptide

A hormone released mainly by heart muscle when it is stretched or under pressure. A blood test measures BNP to help assess possible heart failure. NT-proBNP is a separate peptide measured by a distinct test; the results are not interchangeable. Age and kidney function, among other factors, affect measured levels.

Alternate Names:
BNP; Brain Natriuretic Peptide

Bubo

A tender, enlarged lymph node, usually in the groin, armpit, or neck, caused by infection or inflammation. Buboes are classically linked with plague but also occur in sexually transmitted and other infections.

Bubonic Plague

A serious infection caused by Yersinia pestis, usually spread by infected flea bites. It causes fever and painful swollen lymph nodes and can spread to the blood or lungs.

Buccal

Relating to the cheek or its inner lining. A buccal medicine is placed between the cheek and gum so it dissolves and is absorbed through the mouth.

Buccal Gland

A small salivary gland in the cheek that releases mucus into the mouth. The secretion helps keep the cheek lining moist and supports chewing and swallowing.

Buccal Mucosa

The non-keratinized stratified squamous mucous membrane lining the inside of the cheeks, bounded by the labial commissures anteriorly, the retromolar trigone posteriorly, and the alveolar sulci superiorly and inferiorly. It contains the opening of the parotid duct (Stensen duct) opposite the maxillary second molar and serves as a site for clinical examination of exanthems (such as Koplik spots in measles), oral lichen planus (Wickham striae), aphthous stomatitis, leukoplakia, and drug absorption.

Buccal Smear

A sample of cells gently collected from the inside of the cheek for laboratory testing. It may be used for genetic analysis or, less commonly, to investigate infection or abnormal cells.

Buccinator

A muscle in the cheek that presses the cheek against the teeth. It helps keep food between the teeth and assists sucking, blowing, chewing, and speaking.

Buckle Fracture

Alternate name; see *Torus Fracture*.

Budd-Chiari Syndrome

An uncommon, life-threatening disorder caused by obstruction of hepatic venous outflow at any level from the hepatic venules to the entrance of the inferior vena cava into the right atrium. It classically manifests with the clinical triad of abdominal pain, painful hepatomegaly, and rapidly developing ascites. The obstruction is most commonly thrombotic, strongly associated with underlying hypercoagulable states and myeloproliferative neoplasms (particularly polycythemia vera with the *JAK2* V617F mutation), antiphospholipid syndrome, paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria, pregnancy, or inherited thrombophilias. Doppler ultrasonography is the diagnostic imaging modality of choice.

Alternate Names:
Chiari-Budd Syndrome; Hepatic Venous Outflow Obstruction; Hepatic Vein Thrombosis

Budesonide

A corticosteroid that reduces inflammation. It is used in selected inhaled, nasal, digestive, or rectal treatments for conditions such as asthma, chronic obstructive lung disease, allergic symptoms, and inflammatory bowel disease; side effects depend on the route and dose.

Budvicia

A group of water-associated bacteria related to Yersinia. They rarely cause human disease, but some isolates have been associated with urinary or other opportunistic infections.

Budvicia Aquatica

A water-associated bacterium that has rarely been isolated from human urinary infections, including infections in people with urinary catheters. Its significance depends on symptoms and specimen quality.

Buerger Disease

A nonatherosclerotic inflammatory disease of small

and medium arteries and veins, strongly associated with tobacco exposure. Recurrent inflammation and clotting reduce blood flow and can cause pain, coldness, ulcers, or gangrene in the hands or feet.

Alternate Names:
Buerger's Disease; Thromboangiitis Obliterans; TAO

Buerger's Disease

Alternate name; see *Buerger Disease*.

Buerger Test

A bedside examination for impaired arterial blood flow in the leg. Pallor on elevation and redness when the leg is lowered may occur with severe peripheral arterial disease, but these findings are not specific.

Buffalo Hump

A pad of fat at the back of the neck and upper back. It may occur with obesity, long-term corticosteroid excess, some HIV treatments, or Cushing syndrome and is assessed together with other findings.

Buffer

A chemical solution that resists a change in acidity when small amounts of acid or base are added. Buffers help maintain stable conditions in blood, cells, medicines, and laboratory tests.

Buffer System

A chemical solution consisting of a weak acid and its conjugate base (or a weak base and its conjugate acid) that resists changes in hydrogen ion concentration and pH upon the addition of small amounts of acidic or basic substances.

Buffy Coat

The thin pale layer of white blood cells and platelets that forms between plasma and red blood cells when a blood sample is spun. It can be collected for laboratory testing.

Bufonidae

The family of amphibians commonly called true toads. Some species produce bufotoxins in their skin glands; swallowing or absorbing these toxins can affect the heart and nervous system.

Buformin

An older biguanide medicine for diabetes that has been withdrawn or restricted in many countries because it can cause dangerous lactic-acid buildup, especially when kidney function is poor.

Bug Spray Poisoning

Illness after exposure to an insecticide. Effects depend on the chemical and may include skin or eye irritation, vomiting, breathing difficulty, unusual sweating, confusion, seizures, or other nervous-system problems; severe poisoning can be life-threatening.

Bulbar

Relating to the lower brainstem or to the nerves controlling swallowing, speaking, chewing, coughing, and movement of the tongue and soft palate. Bulbar weakness can allow food or saliva to enter the airway.

Bulbar Conjunctiva

The part of the eye's clear moist covering that lies over the white of the eye. It joins the inner surface of the eyelids around the front of the eye and can become inflamed or injured.

Bulbar Palsy

A lower motor neuron syndrome caused by damage to motor nuclei or fibers of the lower cranial nerves in the brainstem, especially nerves IX, X, and XII. It can cause slurred speech, difficulty swallowing, a weak cough, tongue weakness or wasting, and sometimes breathing problems. It differs from pseudobulbar palsy, which results from bilateral upper motor neuron pathway damage.

Bulbar Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Bulbar Palsy*.

Bulbocavernosus

A paired muscle in the pelvic floor that helps empty the urethra and contributes to erection and ejacu-

lation. It surrounds structures at the base of the penis or the vaginal opening.

Bulbospongiosus

A paired pelvic-floor muscle that helps empty the urethra and assists erection and the release of genital secretions during sexual activity.

Bulbourethral Gland

Either of a pair of small, pea-sized male accessory glands (Cowper glands) situated posterolateral to the membranous urethra within the deep perineal space. During sexual arousal, they secrete an alkaline, clear, mucoid pre-ejaculatory fluid that lubricates the penile urethra and neutralizes acidic residual urine prior to ejaculation.

Alternate Names:
Cowper Gland; Cowper's Gland; Bulbourethral Glands

Bulbourethral Glands

Plural form; see *Bulbourethral Gland*.

Bulging

Projecting or swelling outward beyond the usual shape. A bulge may involve a disc, membrane, organ, skin area, or body wall, and its significance depends on the structure and cause.

Bulging Disc

An intervertebral disc that extends beyond the edge of nearby vertebrae over a broad area. This age-related change is common and may cause no symptoms. In some cases it narrows space around a nerve and contributes to pain, tingling, or weakness; it differs from a focal disc herniation.

Bulging Eyes

Alternate name; see *Exophthalmos*.

Bulging Fontanelle

An outward protrusion or tense swelling of an infant's soft spot (fontanelle) when the baby is calm and upright, indicating elevated intracranial pressure from conditions such as meningitis, encephalitis, hydrocephalus, or intracranial hemorrhage.

Alternate Names:
Tense Fontanelle; Fontanelle Protrusion

Bulimia

Alternate name; see *Bulimia Nervosa*.

Bulimia Nervosa

An eating disorder marked by repeated episodes of eating unusually large amounts of food while feeling unable to stop. These episodes are followed by repeated behaviors to prevent weight gain, such as vomiting, misusing laxatives, fasting, or excessive exercise. A person's view of themselves is strongly affected by body shape or weight.

Alternate Names:
Bulimia; Bulimic Disorder; Binge-Purge Disorder

Bulla

A large fluid-filled blister on the skin or a mucous membrane, or a large air-filled space in an organ such as the lung. The plural is bullae; the term describes the shape of the lesion rather than its cause.

Bullae

Large fluid-filled blisters on or beneath the skin or a mucous membrane. They can result from friction, burns, infection, allergy, medicines, or autoimmune disease; widespread or infected bullae may cause complications.

Bullectomy

An operation to remove one or more large air-filled spaces (bullae) in damaged lung tissue, often to relieve compression of healthier lung.

Alternate Names:
Excision of Pulmonary Bullae; Resection of Giant Bulla

Bullet Track

The path a firearm projectile takes through the body, from the entry wound through injured tissues to an exit wound or a retained bullet. The path may damage skin, organs, blood vessels, nerves, or

bone.

Bullet Wounds

Penetrating or perforating injuries caused by firearm projectiles. They may damage skin, organs, blood vessels, nerves, and bones, even when the external wound looks small.

Bull Neck

Marked swelling of the neck that makes it look thick or rounded. It is classically seen in severe diphtheria of the throat, when swollen lymph nodes and nearby tissues enlarge the neck. The term describes an appearance, not a diagnosis by itself.

Alternate Names:
Bull-neck

Bullosa Hereditaria

Historical term; see *Epidermolysis Bullosa*.

Bullous

Describes a condition involving large, raised, fluid-filled blisters. Bullous disease can result from infection, burns, medicines, allergy, or an autoimmune reaction.

Bullous Myringitis

A painful infection or inflammation of the eardrum that causes small fluid-filled blisters on its surface. It often occurs with a middle-ear infection and may cause temporary hearing loss or fever.

Bullous Disease of Diabetes (Bullosis Diabeticorum)

A rare diabetes-related blistering disorder producing spontaneous, usually painless, tense blisters on the feet or lower legs. Lesions often heal without scarring; secondary infection or another blistering disorder can complicate the picture.

Bullous Emphysema

A severe manifestation of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease characterized by the formation of large, thin-walled air-filled spaces (bullae) exceeding one centimeter in diameter within the lung parenchyma, predisposing to compression of healthy lung and pneumothorax.

Alternate Names:
Vanishing Lung Syndrome

Bullous Impetigo

A contagious superficial bacterial skin infection, usually caused by Staphylococcus, that produces fragile fluid-filled blisters and yellow or varnish-like crusts. It is especially common in infants and young children.

Bullous Pemphigoid

An autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease, most common in older adults, caused by antibodies to proteins at the skin's basement membrane. It often begins with an itchy, hive-like rash followed by tense, fluid-filled blisters. Mucosal involvement is uncommon, and blisters are generally less fragile than those in pemphigus.

Alternate Names:
BP

Bullous Systemic Lupus Erythematosus (BSLE)

A rare autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease occurring in people with systemic lupus erythematosus. It produces tense blisters on normal or inflamed skin and is distinguished from other blistering disorders by its clinical and immunologic features.

Bullying

Repeated physical, verbal, social, or online aggression involving a power imbalance. It can harm mental and physical health.

Bumetanide

A diuretic that makes the kidneys remove extra salt and water in urine. It is used for swelling related to heart, liver, or kidney disease; excessive fluid loss can cause dehydration and abnormal blood salts.

Bumps

Raised or palpable areas on or under the skin. Causes range from harmless cysts, blocked folli-

cles, and insect bites to injury, allergy, infection, or tumours; bumps may be growing, painful, hard, or persistent.

BUN

Alternate name; see *Blood Urea Nitrogen Test*.

Bundle Branch Block

Alternate spelling; see *Bundle-Branch Block*.

Bundle-Branch Block

A delay or blockage along the specialized electrical pathways that carry heartbeat signals through the heart's lower chambers (ventricles). This causes one ventricle to contract slightly later than the other. It is detected as a widened signal pattern on an electrocardiogram (ECG). It is divided into **right bundle-branch block** (which can occur in healthy people or with lung/heart conditions) and **left bundle-branch block** (which is more frequently associated with underlying heart disease).

Bundle Branch Reentry Tachycardia

A form of monomorphic ventricular tachycardia occurring in patients with severe underlying structural heart disease and conduction system disease, in which the reentrant electrical circuit involves the bundle of His and the right and left bundle branches.

Bundle Of His

A short pathway of specialised heart tissue that carries electrical signals from the atria to the ventricles. It divides into right and left branches so the lower chambers contract in a coordinated way.

Bundle of Kent

An abnormal, congenital accessory muscular conduction pathway directly connecting atrial myocardium to ventricular myocardium, bypassing the physiological delay of the atrioventricular node; the anatomical substrate of Wolff-Parkinson-White syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Accessory Atrioventricular Pathway

Bungarotoxins

Poisons in the venom of krait snakes that disrupt nerve signals to muscles. A bite can cause drooping eyelids, weakness, progressive paralysis, and breathing failure.

Bunion

A progressive structural forefoot deformity (hallux valgus) characterized by lateral deviation of the great toe and medial prominence of the first metatarsal head at the first metatarsophalangeal (MTP) joint. It often causes local adventitial bursitis, erythema, pain with ambulation, and difficulty accommodating footwear.

Alternate Names:
Hallux Valgus; Bunions

Bunionectomy

Surgery to correct a bunion by cutting or shifting bone and adjusting surrounding tissues around the big-toe joint.

Bunionette

A bony prominence at the outer side of the joint below the little toe. It may become painful, red, or swollen from pressure, tight shoes, or altered foot mechanics.

Alternate Names:
Tailor's Bunion; Bunion of the Fifth Toe

Bunion Removal

Alternate name; see *Bunionectomy*.

Bunions

Plural form; see *Bunion*.

Bunioplasty

Surgery to correct a bunion by realigning the toe joint and, when needed, balancing nearby soft tissues. The operation is selected according to the deformity and symptoms.

BUN-to-Creatinine Ratio

The ratio of blood urea nitrogen to creatinine. It can provide context when assessing kidney function

and hydration, but diet, bleeding, medicines, muscle mass, and other factors affect it; no single cutoff reliably distinguishes prerenal from intrinsic kidney injury.

Bunyaviridae

An older virus-family grouping that included several viruses spread by insects, ticks, or rodents. Modern classification has changed; individual viruses differ in the illnesses they cause.

Bunyaviruses

A historical collective name for segmented RNA viruses now grouped in the order *Bunyavirales*. Some cause human diseases, including hantavirus disease and Rift Valley fever.

Bunyavirus Infection

An illness caused by a virus in the group historically called bunyaviruses. This group includes viruses that cause hantavirus disease, Rift Valley fever, and some mosquito- or tick-borne infections. Symptoms depend on the virus.

Buphthalmos

Enlargement of an infant's or young child's eye caused by high pressure inside the eye while its outer coat is still flexible. It is usually associated with congenital or infantile glaucoma and can threaten vision.

Bupivacaine

A long-acting local anaesthetic that temporarily blocks nerve signals to prevent pain during local, nerve-block, or epidural procedures. Too much in the bloodstream can cause seizures, dangerous heart effects, or cardiac arrest.

Bupivacaine Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride form of bupivacaine, a long-acting local anaesthetic used to block pain signals. Accidental injection into a blood vessel can cause severe neurologic or heart toxicity.

Buprenorphine

A medicine that partly activates opioid receptors and is used to treat opioid-use disorder and some pain. It can cause dependence and overdose, especially with other sedatives, although respiratory suppression is limited compared with full opioid agonists.

Buprenorphine/Naloxone Toxicity

Opioid toxicity from excessive buprenorphine exposure, characterized by somnolence, miosis, hypoventilation, hypoxia, or coma; risk increases with alcohol, benzodiazepines, or other sedatives. Buprenorphine binds tightly to opioid receptors, so naloxone effects may be delayed or shorter than the toxicity.

Bupropion

A medicine used for depression and, in some settings, to help stop smoking. It changes norepinephrine and dopamine signalling and may cause insomnia, dry mouth, or anxiety; it increases seizure risk and is unsuitable for some seizure or eating disorders.

Buried Penis

A normally developed penis that is concealed by surrounding skin, scar tissue, or excess suprapubic fat. It may cause hygiene problems, recurrent inflammation, difficulty urinating, or sexual difficulties; causes can be congenital, obesity-related, inflammatory, or associated with circumcision complications.

Burkholderia

A group of environmental bacteria found in soil and water. Some species cause melioidosis or glanders, while others cause difficult-to-treat lung, bloodstream, or wound infections, especially in people with chronic lung disease or weakened immunity.

Burkholderiaceae

A family of mainly environmental bacteria that includes Burkholderia. Some members cause serious infections in people or animals, while others are harmless or used in environmental research.

Burkholderia Cenocepacia

A bacterium in the Burkholderia cepacia complex

that can cause severe, persistent lung infection, especially in people with cystic fibrosis or other chronic lung disease.

Burkholderia Cepacia

An environmental bacterium in the Burkholderia cepacia complex. It can cause opportunistic lung, bloodstream, wound, or device-related infection, particularly in people with cystic fibrosis or weakened immunity.

Burkholderia Gladioli

An environmental bacterium that can rarely cause lung, bloodstream, or wound infection, especially in people with cystic fibrosis or weakened immunity.

Burkholderia Mallei

The bacterium that causes glanders, an infection mainly affecting horses and related animals. People can become infected through contact with infected animals or tissues.

Burkholderia Pseudomallei

The bacterium that causes melioidosis. Infection follows contact with contaminated soil or water and may cause pneumonia, abscesses, bloodstream infection, or long-term illness.

Burkitt Lymphoma

A very fast-growing cancer of B lymphocytes, often involving the abdomen, jaw, bone marrow, or nervous system. The pattern differs between endemic, sporadic, and immunodeficiency-associated forms.

Burkitt's Lymphoma

Alternate spelling; see *Burkitt Lymphoma*.

Burkitt's Tumor

Alternate name; see *Burkitt Lymphoma*.

Burn

Tissue trauma caused by thermal agents, chemicals, electricity, radiation, or friction. Burns are classified by depth into superficial (first-degree: erythema, epidermal sparing, no blisters), partial-thickness (second-degree: extending into dermis, weeping blisters, severe pain), full-thickness (third-degree: leathery, white/charred, destruction of dermal appendages and sensory nerves), and fourth-degree (involving deep fascia, muscle, or bone). Extent is quantified by percentage of total body surface area (TBSA) using the Wallace Rule of Nines; severe burns ($>$ 20% TBSA) require prompt fluid resuscitation (e.g., Parkland formula).

Alternate Names:
Thermal Injury; Burn Trauma; Burns

Burning Feet

Burning, tingling, or painful sensations in the feet, often caused by nerve damage from diabetes, nutritional deficiency, alcohol, medicines, or nerve compression. Symptoms may be new, progressive, or associated with weakness.

Burning Mouth Syndrome

Long-lasting burning, scalding, or tingling in the mouth, often felt daily for months or longer even though the mouth looks normal. Taste changes or dry mouth may also occur. Sometimes no cause is found; similar symptoms can also result from low nutrient levels, infection, medicines, allergy, diabetes, or hormone changes.

Burning Thigh Pain

Alternate name; see *Meralgia Paresthetica*.

Burn Injury

Alternate name; see *Burn*.

Burnout

A work-related state of emotional exhaustion, mental distance or cynicism, and reduced effectiveness caused by chronic workplace stress. It is not the same as depression, although both may occur together.

Burns

Plural form; see *Burn*.

Burn Shock

Shock after a major burn, caused by fluid and protein leaking from blood vessels, reduced circulating blood volume, and systemic inflammatory responses. It can impair blood flow to organs and is most likely after extensive burns.

Burn Surgery

Surgical care for serious burns, including assessing depth and area, removing dead tissue, covering wounds, performing skin grafts, and treating scars or movement-limiting contractures.

Burnt-Out Joint

An older description of a joint in which active inflammation has subsided but permanent damage, deformity, pain, or restricted movement remains.

Burn Wound Infections

Infection of damaged skin or deeper tissue after a burn. Features can include increasing pain, redness or swelling spreading beyond the burn, pus, foul odour, delayed healing or graft loss, fever, or other signs of systemic illness.

Burping

Release of swallowed air or gas from the stomach through the mouth. Occasional burping is normal; frequent, painful, or newly worsening burping may result from swallowed air, reflux, food intolerance, or another digestive disorder.

Burr Cells

Erythrocytes that exhibit numerous (usually 10 to 30) short, blunt, evenly spaced, and symmetrical spicules across their entire surface membrane. They are typically observed in end-stage renal disease and uremia, severe hypomagnesemia, and pyruvate kinase deficiency.

Alternate Names:
Echinocytes; Crenated Red Cells

Burr Hole Evacuation

A neurosurgical procedure in which a small opening is drilled through the skull to drain blood or fluid pressing on the brain. It is often used to drain a chronic subdural hematoma. A temporary drain may be left in place to reduce fluid buildup.

Alternate Names:
Burr Hole Drainage; Trephination; Chronic Subdural Hematoma Drainage; Burr Hole Craniostomy

Bursa

A small fluid-filled sac that reduces friction between moving tissues, such as a tendon and bone or skin and bone, especially near a joint. Inflammation of a bursa is called bursitis.

Alternate Names:
Bursae Synovial Bursae

Bursa Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Bursitis*.

Bursectomy

Surgical removal of a bursa, a small fluid-filled sac that reduces friction between tissues.

Bursitis

Inflammation of a bursa, the small fluid-filled sac that cushions movement between tendons, muscles, bones, and skin. It causes localized pain, tenderness, swelling, or reduced movement and may result from pressure, injury, infection, or arthritis.

Bursitis Of The Heel

Inflammation of a bursa near the heel, causing localized tenderness, swelling, and pain when walking or when pressure is applied. It may follow repeated friction, injury, inflammatory arthritis, or infection.

Alternate Names:
Retrocalcaneal Bursitis

Bursitis Of The Foot

Inflammation of a small fluid-filled sac that cushions movement near a foot joint or tendon. It can cause local pain, tenderness, or swelling; see also *Bursitis* and *Bursitis Of The Heel*.

Bursitis of the Knee

Alternate name; see *Knee Bursitis*.

Bursopathy

Any disorder of a bursa, including inflammation, infection, bleeding, thickening, or degeneration. Affected bursae may cause localized pain, swelling, tenderness, and restricted movement around a joint.

Burton Line

A thin, purplish-blue or black discoloration line along the gingival margin at the base of the teeth. Caused by the precipitation of lead sulfide following the chemical reaction between circulating lead and hydrogen sulfide produced by oral bacterial decay; it represents a classical physical sign of chronic lead poisoning (plumbism).

Alternate Names:
Burtonian Line; Lead Line

Buruli Ulcer

A chronic skin infection caused by *Mycobacterium ulcerans*, usually affecting an arm or leg. Its toxin, mycolactone, causes a painless nodule, plaque, or swelling that can progress to an undermined ulcer with extensive tissue destruction and little early inflammation.

Burundanga

A colloquial term for scopolamine (hyoscine hydrobromide), a tropane alkaloid and muscarinic receptor antagonist that induces central anticholinergic effects, anterograde amnesia, sedation, and severe toxicity.

Alternate Names:
Scopolamine; Hyoscine; Hyoscine Hydrobromide

Buserelin

A synthetic gonadotropin-releasing hormone analogue. Continuous treatment first briefly increases and then suppresses pituitary reproductive hormones, lowering ovarian or testicular hormone production in selected fertility and hormone-sensitive conditions.

Buspirone

A nonbenzodiazepine medicine used mainly for generalized anxiety disorder. It acts on serotonin signaling and usually takes days to weeks to help; it does not provide immediate relief from an acute panic attack.

Busulfan

An alkylating chemotherapy medicine used mainly to prepare the body for blood-forming stem-cell transplantation and sometimes to treat chronic myeloid leukemia. It can suppress bone marrow and may cause seizures, infertility, lung injury, or liver damage.

Butanol

A flammable industrial alcohol used as a solvent. Swallowing it or substantial exposure to its vapor can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways and may cause dizziness, vomiting, drowsiness, or other nervous-system effects.

Butazolidin Overdose

Toxic effects from excessive phenylbutazone, an older nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug. Severe exposure may cause gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, bone-marrow suppression, metabolic disturbances, or seizures.

Butocarboxim

A carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Significant exposure can cause cholinergic poisoning, with sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, wheezing, muscle weakness, seizures, or respiratory failure.

Buttiauxella

A genus of environmental gram-negative bacteria in the Enterobacterales; human infection is uncommon and usually opportunistic.

Buttiauxella Agrestis

A species of environmental Gram-negative bacteria found in water, soil, and other natural settings. It is rarely reported from human clinical samples; when detected, the specimen source and the patient's symptoms determine whether it represents infection or harmless contamination.

Buttiauxella Ferragutiae

A species of environmental Gram-negative bacteria. It is uncommon in human disease; its significance in a laboratory specimen depends on source, repeat cultures, symptoms, and other evidence.

Buttiauxella Gaviniae

A species of Buttiauxella bacteria found mainly in environmental samples. Human infection is uncommon; its significance in a clinical specimen depends on the patient's condition.

Buttiauxella Noackiae

A species of environmental Gram-negative bacteria that is rarely associated with human infection. Its significance depends on where it was found, whether it was recovered repeatedly, and whether the patient has compatible symptoms or signs of infection.

Buttock

Either of the paired rounded prominences of the posterior pelvic region overlying the gluteal musculature (gluteus maximus, medius, and minimus) and dense subcutaneous adipose tissue. The gluteal region facilitates upright bipedal posture, locomotion, and sitting weight distribution, and provides landmarks for deep intramuscular injections (e.g., ventrogluteal site).

Alternate Names:
Gluteal Region; Nates; Buttocks

Buttocks

Plural form; see *Buttock*.

Button Batteries

Button batteries are small batteries that can cause severe tissue injury if swallowed or inserted into the nose or ear.

Buttonhole Deformity

Buttonhole deformity is a finger deformity with flexion of the proximal interphalangeal joint and hyperextension of the distal interphalangeal joint, often due to central slip injury or rheumatoid disease.

Button Magnets In The Nasal Cavity

Small magnets placed in or inhaled into the nose can attract across the nasal partition and cut off its blood supply. They may cause tissue death or a hole in the nasal septum.

Buttressing

Buttressing is reinforcement or thickening that supports a weakened structure; in bone it may describe cortical stress adaptation or surgical structural support.

Butylamine

Butylamine is an irritating industrial amine whose vapor or liquid can injure the eyes, skin, and respiratory tract after exposure.

Butyric Acid

Butyric acid is a short-chain fatty acid produced by gut bacteria during fiber fermentation and used by colon cells as an energy source; concentrated exposure irritates tissue.

B Virus

A herpes virus carried mainly by macaques. It can cause a rare but severe infection of the brain and spinal cord in people after a bite, scratch, or contact with infected animal tissue.

Bx

A common medical abbreviation for biopsy, the removal of cells or tissue for microscopic or laboratory examination.

By-Pass

Alternate spelling; see *Bypass*.

Bypass

Creation of an alternative route around a blocked or narrowed passage. A bypass can restore blood flow or redirect body contents, using a natural pathway, tube, vein, or artificial graft depending on the organ involved.

Bypass Graft

A vein or artificial tube surgically connected to route blood around a blocked or weakened artery. Grafts are used in coronary, leg, and aortic operations; blood flow, infection, clotting, and long-term narrowing affect their durability.

Bypass Surgery

An operation that creates a new route around a blocked or diseased passage. Examples include coronary and leg-artery bypasses and gastric bypass; possible complications include bleeding, infection, clotting, and narrowing of the connection.

Byssinosis

An occupational lung disease caused by repeated inhalation of dust from cotton, flax, hemp, or other textile fibers. It can cause chest tightness, cough, and breathing difficulty that worsen during or after work exposure.

Alternate Names:
Brown Lung Disease

C

C-11 Hydroxylase Deficiency

A form of congenital adrenal hyperplasia caused by impaired 11-beta-hydroxylase activity. Reduced cortisol synthesis increases adrenal androgens and deoxycorticosterone, which may cause androgen excess, virilization, hypertension, and low potassium.

C-17 Hydroxylase Deficiency

A form of congenital adrenal hyperplasia caused by impaired 17-alpha-hydroxylase activity. It reduces cortisol and sex-steroid production and may cause hypertension, low potassium, undervirilization, or absent puberty.

C1-INH

Abbreviation for C1 esterase inhibitor, a complement-regulating protein. Inherited or acquired deficiency or dysfunction can cause recurrent episodes of bradykinin-mediated angioedema affecting the skin, abdomen, or airway.

C1Q Nephropathy

A rare kidney disorder in which an immune protein called C1q collects in the kidney's filtering units. It may cause blood or protein in the urine, swelling, high blood pressure, or reduced kidney function.

C282Y Mutation

A change in the HFE gene that is the most common genetic cause of hereditary hemochromatosis, a condition in which the body stores too much iron. Having two copies of this mutation increases the risk, although not everyone with two copies develops the disease.

CA-125

A blood protein that may rise in ovarian and some other cancers. It can also increase with menstruation, pregnancy, endometriosis, infection, liver disease, or other noncancerous conditions, so it cannot diagnose ovarian cancer alone.

Alternate Names:
Cancer Antigen 125; Carbohydrate Antigen 125; MUC16

CA-125 Blood Test

See *CA-125*.

CA 19-9

A substance measured in blood that may be increased in pancreatic and other digestive-system cancers. It can also rise with blocked bile ducts or inflammation, so it cannot screen for or diagnose cancer by itself.

CA 27-29

A blood test that measures a protein sometimes released by breast-cancer cells. It may help monitor selected people with known breast cancer but cannot by itself screen for or diagnose cancer.

Cabazitaxel

A taxane chemotherapy medicine used with prednisone for metastatic castration-resistant prostate cancer after docetaxel. It can cause low white-cell counts, infection, diarrhea, and serious allergic reactions.

Cabergoline

A dopamine D2-receptor agonist used to suppress

prolactin secretion and treat hyperprolactinemia; it is also used in selected Parkinson disease settings and requires monitoring for adverse effects.

CABG

Abbreviation; see *Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting*.

Cabot Ring

A thread-like or ring-shaped remnant sometimes seen inside a red blood cell on a blood smear. It may occur when red blood cells are being made abnormally, including in severe anemia, but it is not a diagnosis by itself.

Cachectic

Affected by cachexia, a severe wasting syndrome involving involuntary weight loss, muscle loss, weakness, and often reduced appetite in chronic disease.

Cachetic

Common misspelling; see *Cachectic*.

Cachexia

A wasting syndrome caused by serious long-term illness, marked by ongoing unintentional loss of weight, muscle, and body fat. It may cause poor appetite, weakness, and inflammation and cannot be corrected by nutrition alone.

Cacosmia

A distorted sense of smell in which ordinary odors seem unusually foul or unpleasant. It may occur with nose or sinus disease, infection, seizures, head injury, or another nervous-system disorder.

CAD

Coronary artery disease, narrowing or blockage of the arteries supplying the heart, usually caused by fatty plaque. It can reduce oxygen to heart muscle and cause chest pain, heart attack, heart failure, or dangerous rhythms.

CADASIL Syndrome

An inherited disorder of small brain blood vessels caused by changes in the NOTCH3 gene. It may cause migraine with aura, repeated strokes, mood changes, and gradually worsening memory or thinking problems.

CAD (Coronary Artery Disease)

Expanded form of the abbreviation; see *CAD*.

Cadherin

A cell-surface protein that helps neighboring cells attach to one another and keeps tissues organized. Loss or alteration of cadherins can allow some cancer cells to invade nearby tissue and spread.

Cadmium

A toxic metal found in tobacco smoke, some batteries and pigments, workplace dust, and contaminated food or soil. Long-term exposure can damage the kidneys, lungs, and bones and increases the risk of some cancers.

Caduceus

A winged staff with two entwined snakes, traditionally associated with Hermes. It is often used incorrectly as a medical symbol and differs from the single-snake Rod of Asclepius.

Cadusafos

An organophosphate pesticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase, causing excess nerve signaling after exposure. Poisoning may produce sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle weakness, breathing difficulty, or seizures.

Caecal

Relating to the caecum, the pouch at the beginning of the large intestine where the small intestine joins the colon and the appendix begins.

Caecitis

Inflammation of the caecum, the first part of the large intestine. It may result from infection, inflammatory bowel disease, reduced blood flow, neutropenia, or spread of nearby inflammation and can cause right-sided abdominal pain and fever.

Caecopexy

An operation that attaches the caecum, the first pouch of the large intestine, to nearby tissue to prevent or treat abnormal movement or twisting.

Caecostomy

An operation that creates an opening from the caecum to the abdominal wall. It may temporarily release pressure, drain the bowel, or divert stool when the normal route is blocked or unsafe.

Caecotomy

A surgical incision into the caecum, the first part of the large intestine, to gain access to its interior or as part of another abdominal operation. The incision is generally closed during the procedure.

Caecum

The first pouch-like part of the large intestine, located where the ileum joins the colon and attached to the appendix.

Caesarean Birth

Alternate name; see *Cesarean Section*.

Caesarean Section

Alternate spelling; see *Cesarean Section*.

Cafe-Au-Lait Macules

Alternate spelling; see *Café-Au-Lait Macules*.

Café-Au-Lait Macules

Flat, light-brown skin patches with relatively uniform pigmentation. Multiple lesions may be associated with genetic disorders such as neurofibromatosis type 1.

Cafe-Au-Lait Spot

Alternate name; see *Café-Au-Lait Macules*.

Café Au Lait Spot

Alternate name; see *Café-Au-Lait Macules*.

Café Coronary

Older term for choking caused by food blocking the airway; see *Choking*.

Caffeine

A stimulant found in coffee, tea, chocolate, soft drinks, and energy drinks. It increases alertness and can raise heart rate, cause shakiness, or disturb sleep.

Caffeine Intoxication

Alternate name; see *Caffeine Toxicity*.

Caffeine Overdose

Alternate name; see *Caffeine Toxicity*.

Caffeine Toxicity

Illness caused by taking in too much caffeine. It may cause restlessness, shaking, nausea, vomiting, or a fast heartbeat. Severe poisoning can cause dangerous heart rhythms, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Caffeine Withdrawal

A group of symptoms after suddenly reducing or stopping regular caffeine use. Headache, tiredness, low mood, poor concentration, irritability, nausea, or flu-like feelings usually begin within a day and improve within several days.

Caisson Disease

Decompression sickness caused by gas bubbles forming in tissues or blood after a rapid fall in surrounding pressure, such as after diving. It can cause joint pain, skin changes, breathing problems, brain or spinal-cord injury, or collapse.

Caladium Plant Poisoning

Poisoning from chewing or swallowing caladium, whose needle-like calcium oxalate crystals irritate the mouth and throat. Burning, pain, drooling, and swelling may occur; trouble breathing or swallowing is an emergency.

Calamine

A topical preparation, usually containing zinc oxide with small amounts of ferric oxide, used to relieve itching and irritation. It is applied to the skin and has a mild astringent effect.

Calbindin

A protein that binds calcium inside cells and helps control calcium levels and cell signaling, especially in nerve and intestinal cells. Laboratories may also use it as a marker to identify certain tissues.

Calcaneal Spur

A bony growth from the heel bone, usually where the plantar fascia or Achilles tendon attaches. It may cause no symptoms; when heel pain occurs, the associated soft-tissue inflammation is often more important than the spur itself.

Calcaneal Tendon

Alternate name; see *Achilles Tendon*.

Calcaneal Valgus

An outward tilting of the heel so that the foot rolls toward the body's midline. It may occur with flat feet, altered lower-limb alignment, or developmental and neuromuscular conditions and can affect walking or cause pain.

Calcaneum

Alternate name for the calcaneus; see *Calcaneus*.

Calcaneus

The largest tarsal bone, forming the heel. It supports body weight and articulates with the talus and cuboid; fractures may occur after falls from height.

Calcarine Sulcus

An anatomical fissure located on the medial surface of the occipital lobe of the brain, running horizontally from the parieto-occipital sulcus to the occipital pole; its upper and lower banks constitute the primary visual cortex (Brodmann area 17).

Alternate Names:
Calcarine Fissure

Calcifediol

The main circulating storage form of vitamin D, also called 25-hydroxyvitamin D. A blood test for calcifediol is used to assess vitamin-D status before the body converts it to the active hormone calcitriol.

Calciferol

A fat-soluble form of vitamin D that helps the body absorb calcium and phosphate and maintain healthy bones, muscles, and immune function. The body changes it into active vitamin-D hormones.

Calcification

Deposition of calcium salts in tissue. It is normal in bone and teeth; in other tissues it may follow local injury or inflammation, or occur when calcium or phosphate levels in the blood are abnormal. The affected tissue and distribution of deposits help distinguish these processes.

Calcific Bursitis

A condition in which calcium deposits form in or around a bursa, often near the shoulder, causing pain, tenderness, swelling, and restricted movement. Treatment depends on severity and may include rest, physical therapy, medicines, drainage, or deposit removal.

Alternate Names:
Calcifying Bursitis; Hydroxyapatite Bursitis

Calcific Tendinitis

A condition in which calcium crystals build up inside a tendon, most often a rotator-cuff tendon in the shoulder. It can cause sudden severe pain, stiffness, and restricted movement, sometimes followed by gradual improvement as deposits break down.

Calcific Uremic Arteriolopathy

Alternate name; see *Calciphylaxis*.

Calcified Granuloma

A small area of past inflammation that has healed and become hardened by calcium deposits. It is

often found in the lung after an old infection and usually does not represent active disease.

Calcineurin

A protein that helps activate T cells, which are immune cells, after they receive signals. Medicines that block it reduce immune activity and are used to prevent transplant rejection and treat selected immune diseases.

Calcinos

Older or shortened term; see *Calcinosis*.

Calcinosis

Abnormal deposition of insoluble calcium salts in the skin or deeper soft tissues, often associated with autoimmune connective-tissue disease, kidney disease, trauma, or an abnormal calcium-phosphate balance. Firm white or yellow nodules or plaques may be painful, restrict movement, ulcerate, or release chalky material.

Calcinosis Cutis

Deposition of calcium salts in the skin or subcutaneous tissue, producing firm white or yellow papules, nodules, or plaques. Lesions may be painless or tender, restrict movement, ulcerate, or discharge chalky material; the cause and blood calcium or phosphate levels guide evaluation.

Calciphylaxis

A rare disorder in which calcification and fibrosis of small blood vessels, followed by thrombosis, reduce blood flow and cause severe tissue injury. It usually occurs with advanced kidney disease but can also occur without it. Painful, purplish skin lesions may progress to ulcers and tissue death.

Alternate Names:
Calciphylaxis Cutis; CUA; Vascular Calcification-Uremic Syndrome

Calcitonin

A hormone made by specialized cells in the thyroid gland. It helps lower blood calcium by reducing calcium release from bone and increasing calcium loss through the kidneys, although it has a smaller role than parathyroid hormone in adults.

Calcitonin Blood Test

A blood test that measures calcitonin, a hormone produced by thyroid C cells. It is used mainly to evaluate or monitor medullary thyroid carcinoma and may be affected by other thyroid, kidney, gastrointestinal, or medicine-related factors.

Calcitriol

The active hormone made from vitamin D, mainly by the kidneys. It increases intestinal absorption of calcium and phosphate and helps regulate parathyroid hormone, bone formation, and blood-mineral levels.

Calcitriol And Analogues

Medicines related to the active form of vitamin D that reduce excessive parathyroid-hormone release and help correct mineral imbalance in some kidney disorders. They can raise calcium or phosphate, so blood levels require monitoring.

Calcium

A mineral needed for strong bones and teeth, muscle movement, nerve signals, blood clotting, and normal cell function. Blood calcium exists in an active free form and forms attached to proteins or other substances.

Calcium Blood Test

A blood test that measures calcium, usually as total calcium. The result may be interpreted with albumin, a blood protein, or measured as ionized calcium when the active form is needed. It helps assess parathyroid, bone, and kidney disorders.

Calcium Carbonate

A calcium supplement and antacid that neutralizes stomach acid. Excessive use can cause constipation, high blood calcium, or kidney problems and may interfere with medicine absorption.

Calcium Carbonate Overdose

Overdose of calcium carbonate that may cause gas-

trointestinal symptoms, hypercalcemia, alkalosis, kidney injury, or kidney stones.

Calcium Carbonate With Magnesium Overdose

Taking too much of these antacid ingredients can cause nausea, vomiting, constipation or diarrhea, weakness, confusion, abnormal calcium or magnesium levels, and kidney injury. Effects are more severe with impaired kidney function.

Calcium Channel

A protein in the cell membrane that controls calcium entry into cells. Calcium channels help regulate muscle contraction, the release of substances, nerve signals, and heart rhythm.

Calcium Channel Blocker Toxicity

Poisoning from excessive exposure to a calcium-channel blocker. It can impair heart contraction and conduction and widen blood vessels, causing low blood pressure, slow heart rate, heart block, high blood glucose, shock, or cardiac arrest; severity depends on the drug and amount.

Calcium Chloride

A calcium salt given by injection for severe low blood calcium, dangerously high potassium, or certain toxic exposures. Leakage outside the vein can cause serious tissue injury.

Calcium Citrate

A calcium supplement that is absorbed even when stomach acid is low. It may prevent or treat calcium deficiency but can cause constipation and, in some people, contribute to kidney stones.

Calcium Deficiency

Inadequate calcium intake or absorption over time, which can impair bone mineralization and contribute to rickets in children or osteomalacia and bone loss in adults. It is distinct from hypocalcemia, an abnormally low calcium concentration in the blood, which has several possible causes and can produce neuromuscular symptoms.

Calcium for Osteoporosis

Calcium is a mineral required for bone formation and maintenance. Adequate intake supports osteoporosis prevention and treatment, but calcium alone does not reverse established osteoporosis; excessive supplementation can cause constipation, kidney stones, or hypercalcemia.

Calcium Gluconate

A calcium salt taken by mouth or given by injection to treat calcium deficiency and some emergencies, including dangerously high potassium or magnesium. Intravenous treatment requires medical monitoring because it can affect the heart and veins.

Calcium Homeostasis

Regulation of calcium concentration in the blood and tissues by coordinated actions of the bones, intestines, kidneys, parathyroid glands, and vitamin D. Calcium homeostasis supports nerve signaling, muscle contraction, blood clotting, and bone maintenance.

Calcium Hydroxide Poisoning

Exposure to a strongly alkaline chemical that can burn the mouth, throat, esophagus, skin, or eyes. Eye, breathing, or swallowing problems may occur with severe exposure.

Calcium Phosphate

A mineral that forms much of the hard structure of bones and teeth. Excess calcium phosphate can also deposit in soft tissues, especially after tissue damage or when blood calcium or phosphate levels are abnormal.

Calcium Pyrophosphate Arthritis

Inflammation caused by calcium pyrophosphate crystals in cartilage or a joint. Sudden attacks, often called pseudogout, commonly affect the knee or wrist; chronic deposits can cause ongoing arthritis and joint damage.

Calcium Pyrophosphate Crystals

Rhomboid or rod-shaped crystals that deposit in cartilage and other joint tissues. In joint fluid, they

are usually weakly positively birefringent or may show no birefringence under polarized light; their deposition causes calcium pyrophosphate deposition disease.

Alternate Names:
CPP Crystals; CPPD Crystals

Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition

Alternate index label; see *Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition Disease*.

Calcium Pyrophosphate Deposition Disease

A disorder in which calcium pyrophosphate crystals collect in cartilage and joints. It may cause sudden painful swelling of one joint, usually the knee or wrist, or a chronic arthritis that resembles osteoarthritis or rheumatoid arthritis.

Calcium Sensing Receptor

A protein in the parathyroid glands and kidneys that detects the blood calcium level. It helps control parathyroid hormone and influences how much calcium and phosphate the kidneys keep or remove.

Calcium Signaling

A way cells communicate using changes in calcium concentration. These signals help control muscle contraction, secretion of substances, energy use, movement, and activity of genes.

Calcium Stones

The most common type of kidney stone, made mainly of calcium oxalate or calcium phosphate. Low urine volume and certain mineral imbalances increase risk; stones may cause severe side pain, blood in the urine, blockage, or infection.

Calcium Test

A blood test measuring total or ionized calcium to evaluate parathyroid function, bone disorders, kidney disease, and electrolyte balance; see *Calcium*.

Calciuria

Calcium excretion in urine. It is measured in a timed or 24-hour collection when assessing calcium balance, kidney-stone risk, or disorders of mineral metabolism. Excess calcium in urine is called hypercalciuria and may occur with endocrine disease, kidney-tubule disorders, diet, or certain medicines.

Calculi

Alternate plural; see *Calculus*.

Calculus

A hard concretion that forms in an organ or duct, often composed of mineral salts. Examples include urinary, biliary, and salivary stones; mineralized dental plaque is called dental calculus.

Calculus Removal

Professional dental treatment that removes hardened plaque from teeth and below the gumline using hand or ultrasonic instruments. It helps control gum inflammation and may include deep cleaning of affected tooth roots.

Caldwell-Luc Operation

An operation that reaches the maxillary sinus through the upper gum and jawbone. It is used selectively to treat or examine certain sinus lesions, chronic disease, or foreign bodies when less invasive routes are unsuitable.

Calf

The back part of the lower leg between the knee and ankle. It contains the gastrocnemius, soleus, blood vessels, nerves, and other tissues and helps point the foot downward and propel walking.

Calf Pseudohypertrophy

An enlarged, firm appearance of the calf muscles caused mainly by replacement of damaged muscle with fat and fibrous tissue rather than increased muscle strength. It is seen especially in Duchenne and Becker muscular dystrophies and some related disorders.

Alternate Names:
Pseudohypertrophy of the Calves; Muscular Pseudohypertrophy

Calibration

Checking and, when necessary, adjusting a medical or laboratory instrument against a known standard so its measurements are accurate and reliable. Regular calibration supports correct diagnosis, treatment, and patient safety.

Caliciviridae

A family of viruses that includes norovirus and sapovirus, which commonly cause vomiting and diarrhea. Other members infect animals; illness depends on the particular virus, the person or animal infected, and the route of exposure.

Calipers

An instrument with two arms used to measure distance, thickness, or body dimensions. In health care, calipers may measure skinfold thickness, joint movement, wounds, or the size of body structures.

Calla Lily Poisoning

Poisoning from chewing or swallowing calla lily, whose needle-like calcium oxalate crystals irritate the mouth and throat. Burning, pain, drooling, and swelling may occur; breathing or swallowing difficulty requires emergency care.

Callosal

Relating to the corpus callosum, the broad bundle of nerve fibers connecting the left and right halves of the brain. Callosal abnormalities can affect communication between the two sides.

Callosity

A small area of thick, hardened skin caused by repeated pressure or rubbing. It commonly develops on the hands or feet and may become painful if the pressure continues.

Callosotomy

Surgical division of the corpus callosum to reduce the spread of certain severe, treatment-resistant seizures between the cerebral hemispheres.

Callus

A thick, hardened area of skin formed by repeated pressure or rubbing. Calluses commonly occur on hands or feet, usually cause no harm, and may become painful or crack when extensive.

Calluses and Corns

Localized areas of thickened skin caused by repeated pressure or friction. Calluses are broader; corns are more focal and often painful. Diabetes, poor circulation, or infection requires professional foot care rather than self-cutting.

Calmodulin

A protein inside cells that senses calcium and passes its signals to other proteins. It helps control muscle contraction, movement of substances through cell membranes, chemical reactions, and activity of genes.

Calnexin

A protein inside cells that helps newly made proteins fold into the correct shape. It checks proteins before they are sent to other parts of the cell or broken down.

Calor

Abnormal warmth of a body part, usually caused by increased blood flow during inflammation. It may occur with redness, swelling, pain, or reduced function.

Caloric Restriction

Deliberately eating fewer calories without causing malnutrition. It may help with weight loss and some metabolic risks, but it should provide enough protein, vitamins, minerals, and other nutrients.

Caloric Stimulation

A balance test in which warm or cool air or water is placed in the ear canal. The temperature briefly stimulates the inner-ear balance organs and helps compare the balance nerve on each side.

Calorie

A unit of energy. In nutrition, one Calorie with a capital C equals one kilocalorie (kcal), the energy needed to raise the temperature of one kilogram of water by one degree Celsius.

Alternate Names:
Kilocalorie; Kcal; Calories

Calorimetry

Measurement of heat production or gas exchange to estimate how much energy the body uses. Indirect calorimetry uses oxygen consumption and carbon-dioxide production to help assess metabolism and nutritional needs.

Calot Triangle

The hepatocystic triangle is bounded by the cystic duct, the common hepatic duct, and the inferior surface of the liver. It contains the cystic artery in most people and is a landmark in gallbladder surgery. Calot's original triangle instead used the cystic artery as its superior boundary; the two descriptions should not be conflated.

Alternate Names:
Triangle of Calot; Cystohepatic Triangle

Calpain

A group of enzymes activated by calcium that cut selected proteins inside cells. They help regulate cell movement, signaling, programmed cell death, and platelet activity; abnormal calpain activity contributes to some muscle and nervous-system diseases.

Calpainopathy

An inherited muscle disease caused by harmful changes in both copies of the CAPN3 gene. It slowly weakens hip, pelvic, shoulder, and trunk muscles, often causing shoulder-blade winging, back curvature, difficulty climbing, and walking problems while usually sparing facial and heart muscles.

Alternate Names:
Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophy R1 (LGMD R1); LGMD 2A; Calpain-3 Deficiency

Calponin

A protein that binds to actin, a component of the cell's internal framework, and helps regulate contraction in smooth muscle. Laboratory staining for calponin can help identify muscle-related cells in tissue samples.

Calprotectin

A protein released mainly by activated white blood cells. Measuring it in stool helps detect inflammation in the intestines, particularly in inflammatory bowel disease, and can help distinguish it from some noninflammatory conditions.

Calreticulin

A protein inside cells that helps newly made proteins fold correctly and helps regulate calcium storage and immune signaling. Harmful changes in its gene are found in some blood cancers involving excessive production of blood cells.

Calretinin

A calcium-binding protein found in certain nerve cells and cells lining body cavities. Pathologists may use calretinin staining to help distinguish mesothelioma from some other cancers in a tissue sample.

Calvaria

The dome-shaped upper part of the skull that covers and protects the brain. It is formed mainly by the flat bones of the forehead, top and sides of the head, and back of the skull.

Calvarium

The dome-like portion of the skull formed mainly by the frontal, parietal, and occipital bones. It encloses and protects the upper parts of the brain.

Calyx

A cup-shaped body structure that supports tissue or collects fluid. In the kidney, renal calyces collect urine from the pyramids and carry it toward the renal pelvis.

Cambridge Classification

A grading system used with endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography to describe chronic pancreatitis. It rates abnormalities of the main pancreatic duct and its branches, from normal or uncertain findings to mild, moderate, or severe disease.

Cameron Lesions

Long, shallow erosions or ulcers in the stomach where it is squeezed by the diaphragm, usually in people with a large hiatal hernia. They may cause chronic blood loss, iron-deficiency anemia, or visible gastrointestinal bleeding.

Camphor

A strong-smelling substance used in some topical products and traditional remedies. Swallowing even a relatively small amount can cause nausea, agitation, drowsiness, or rapidly developing seizures and may be life-threatening.

Camphor Overdose

Toxic exposure to too much camphor, causing nausea, vomiting, agitation, drowsiness, seizures, coma, or slowed breathing. Seizures may begin quickly after ingestion.

Camphor-Phenol Product Poisoning

Toxicity after swallowing a topical product containing camphor and phenol. Camphor can cause nausea, agitation, drowsiness, and rapidly developing seizures; phenol can injure tissues and affect the nervous system, heart, liver, or kidneys.

Campimetry

Measurement and mapping of the area a person can see while looking straight ahead. It helps detect and describe visual-field loss caused by disease of the retina, optic nerve, or brain pathways.

Campomelic Dysplasia

A rare inherited disorder caused by changes affecting the SOX9 gene. It causes bowed long bones, poorly developed shoulder blades, characteristic facial features, and often serious problems with breathing or other organs.

Camptocormia

Severe forward bending of the trunk that worsens while standing or walking and improves when lying down. It may result from muscle disease, Parkinson disease, dystonia, or another nerve or muscle disorder.

Camptodactyly

A fixed bending deformity of one or more fingers, usually at the middle finger joint. It may be present from birth or develop later because of shortened tendons, muscles, connective tissue, or joint structures.

Campylobacter

A group of bacteria that commonly cause foodborne intestinal infection. Illness may include fever, abdominal cramps, diarrhea, or bloody stools; some species can invade the bloodstream or cause later nerve or joint problems.

Campylobacter Coli

A Campylobacter species that can cause foodborne intestinal infection, usually after contaminated meat, water, or other food. Symptoms include fever, abdominal cramps, diarrhea, and sometimes bloody stools.

Campylobacter Enteritis

An acute bacterial foodborne or waterborne diarrheal illness caused predominantly by *Campylobacter jejuni*, presenting with fever, severe cramping abdominal pain mimicking appendicitis, and inflammatory bloody diarrhea, with potential post-infectious Guillain-Barre syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Campylobacteriosis

Campylobacter Fetus

A Campylobacter species that can cause bloodstream infection and infections of blood vessels, joints, the brain, or other tissues. Serious disease is more likely in older adults and people with weakened immunity.

Campylobacter Food Poisoning

A foodborne infection caused by Campylobacter bacteria, often from undercooked poultry, unpasteurized milk, or contaminated water. It causes diarrhea, cramps, and fever and may rarely trigger bloodstream infection or nerve inflammation.

Campylobacter Infection

A bacterial infection, usually caused by C. jejuni or C. coli, acquired from contaminated poultry, food, water, or unpasteurized milk. It causes fever, cramps, and diarrhea that may be bloody; rare complications include bloodstream infection, arthritis, or Guillain–Barré syndrome.

Campylobacteriosis

Infection caused by Campylobacter bacteria, usually producing fever, abdominal pain, and diarrhea that may be bloody. Dehydration is common; rare complications include bloodstream infection, reactive arthritis, and Guillain–Barré syndrome.

Campylobacter Jejuni

A major cause of foodborne intestinal infection, usually acquired from undercooked poultry, contaminated water, or unpasteurized milk. It commonly causes fever, abdominal cramps, and diarrhea that may contain blood.

Campylobacter Serology Test

A blood test that detects antibodies produced after Campylobacter infection. It may support evaluation of selected complications after infection, but stool molecular testing or culture is generally used to diagnose active intestinal disease.

Canagliflozin

A medicine that lowers blood glucose by causing the kidneys to remove more glucose in urine. It may also reduce some heart-failure and kidney risks, but can cause genital infections, dehydration, low blood pressure, or ketoacidosis.

Canaliculus

A small anatomical channel. The tear canaliculi are tiny passages in the eyelids that carry tears from the eye surface into the lacrimal sac and then the nose.

Canalith Repositioning Maneuver

A series of guided head and body movements designed to relocate displaced otolith calcium carbonate crystals (canaliths) from a semicircular canal back into the utricle, where they no longer provoke positional nystagmus or vertigo. Most commonly performed as the Epley maneuver for posterior canal benign paroxysmal positional vertigo (BPPV) or the Lempert (barbecue roll) maneuver for horizontal canal BPPV.

Canalith Repositioning Maneuvers

Plural form; see *Canalith Repositioning Maneuver*.

Canalization

Formation or restoration of a channel through tissue, a blood vessel, or an embryonic structure. In a blood clot, canalization means that small channels form through the clot and partly restore blood flow.

Canal Of Schlemm

A circular drainage channel at the edge of the cornea that carries aqueous fluid from the front of the eye into the bloodstream. Poor drainage can raise eye pressure and contribute to glaucoma.

Canavan Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which deficiency of the ASPA enzyme damages the brain's white matter. It usually begins in infancy with poor muscle tone, delayed development, increasing head size, feeding problems, and later severe movement and communication impairment.

Cancellous Bone

Porous bone made of thin supporting plates or struts. It is found inside many bones, especially near joints and in the vertebrae, and contains marrow while helping distribute forces.

Cancer

A group of diseases in which abnormal cells grow

without normal control. They can invade nearby tissue or spread to other parts of the body; this spread is called metastasis. Cancer can begin in almost any tissue. Some cancers, such as leukemia, do not form solid tumors. A benign growth is not cancer and does not spread in this way.

Cancer And Lymph Nodes

Cancer cells may travel from a primary tumor to nearby lymph nodes through lymphatic vessels. Examination, imaging, or biopsy of these nodes helps determine the cancer's extent and guide treatment.

Cancer-Associated Thrombosis

A blood clot in a vein or artery occurring with active cancer or its treatment. Cancer, surgery, immobility, central lines, and some treatments increase risk; anticoagulant treatment is chosen according to clot location, bleeding risk, and cancer status.

Cancer Care Team

The health professionals who work together to diagnose, treat, and support a person with cancer. Depending on the illness, the team may include medical and radiation oncologists, surgeons, pathologists, nurses, pharmacists, therapists, and palliative-care specialists.

Cancer Cell

A cell with changes that allow it to grow and survive without normal control. Cancer cells may lose their specialized function, resist cell death, invade nearby tissues, enter blood or lymph, and form tumors elsewhere.

Cancer Cluster

A group or area with more cancer cases than expected during a specified time. Investigation compares the number and types of cancers with reliable background rates and examines possible shared exposures while considering chance variation.

Cancer Genetics

The study of inherited and acquired genetic changes that affect cancer risk, behavior, or treatment. Testing may identify inherited risk syndromes or changes in a tumor that help guide treatment and family counseling.

Cancer Grading

Assessment of how abnormal cancer cells and their tissue pattern look under a microscope. The grade gives information about likely growth behavior and is different from staging, which describes how far the cancer has spread.

Cancer Immunotherapy

Cancer treatment that helps the immune system recognize or attack cancer cells. Methods include checkpoint inhibitors, engineered immune cells, immune-stimulating proteins, and some vaccines; use and side effects depend on the cancer and treatment.

Cancer in Lung

Alternate name; see *Lung Cancer*.

Cancer Mutations

Genetic changes in cancer cells that can alter growth, survival, or spread. Most develop during life and are not inherited. Some drive cancer development, while others have little effect; testing selected changes can help guide prognosis or targeted treatment.

Cancer Nutrition

Nutrition care for people with cancer, who may lose appetite or weight because of the disease or treatment. Individual plans may address calories, protein, fluids, swallowing, nausea, diarrhea, and cachexia while respecting the person's goals and treatment.

Cancer of the Ear

Cancer arising in the outer ear or ear canal; less often, it begins in the middle ear or temporal bone. Most cancers of the outer ear and ear canal arise from skin cells, commonly as squamous cell carcinoma or basal cell carcinoma.

Cancer of the Tongue

Malignant tumor arising in the tongue, most often squamous cell carcinoma. It may appear as a per-

sistent sore, lump, bleeding area, or numb patch, or cause difficulty swallowing or unexplained tongue pain.

Cancer Of Unknown Origin

Alternate index label; see *Carcinoma Of Unknown Primary*.

Cancer Of Unknown Primary

Alternate name; see *Carcinoma Of Unknown Primary*.

Cancer Pain

Pain caused by a tumor, its spread, or its treatment. It may be constant or intermittent and can arise from bone, nerves, organs, surgery, radiation, or medicines; treatment combines control of the cause with suitable pain relief and supportive care.

Alternate Names:
Malignancy-Related Pain; Oncologic Pain

Cancer Prevention

Actions that lower the chance of developing cancer or find precancerous changes early. They include avoiding tobacco, limiting alcohol, vaccination against cancer-causing infections, protecting skin from ultraviolet light, reducing harmful exposures, and recommended screening.

Cancer Progression

Growth or spread of cancer or worsening of its effects over time. Progression may occur at the original site, in nearby lymph nodes, or in distant organs and is assessed with symptoms, examination, imaging, laboratory tests, or biopsy.

Cancer Recurrence

Cancer that returns after a period when it could not be detected. It may recur near the original site or in another part of the body and may be called local, regional, or distant recurrence.

Cancer-Related Fatigue

Persistent physical, emotional, or mental exhaustion caused by cancer, its treatment, or related problems. It may occur even after little activity and may not improve fully with sleep or rest.

Cancer Risk

The likelihood that a person will develop cancer. It is influenced by age, inherited variants, family history, tobacco, alcohol, certain infections, radiation, environmental exposures, body weight, and chance; having a risk factor does not guarantee cancer.

Cancer Screening

Testing people who have no symptoms to find selected cancers or precancerous changes early, when treatment may work better. Each test has specific age, risk, interval, benefits, and possible harms.

Cancers of the Oral Mucosa

Malignant tumors arising in the moist lining of the mouth, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma. They may cause persistent ulcers, red or white patches, lumps, bleeding, pain, numbness, or swallowing difficulty; tobacco, alcohol, HPV, and other factors can contribute.

Cancer Staging

Describing how far a cancer has grown or spread. Assessment may include the primary tumor, nearby lymph nodes, distant metastases, scans, and tissue examination; stage helps guide treatment and estimate prognosis.

Cancer Surveillance

Ongoing monitoring for cancer recurrence, progression, treatment effects, or new cancers after diagnosis or treatment. It may include examinations, imaging, laboratory tests, and symptom review according to the cancer and treatment.

Cancer Survivor

A person living with cancer from diagnosis through treatment and afterward. The term includes people whose cancer is controlled or cured and those with ongoing disease; follow-up may address recurrence, late effects, emotional health, and quality of life.

Cancer Susceptibility Genes

Genes in which inherited harmful variants increase the chance of developing one or more cancers. Examples include BRCA1, BRCA2, APC, and mismatch-repair genes; carrying a risk variant does not guarantee that cancer will develop.

Cancer Treatment

Any intervention aimed at curing, prolonging survival, or palliating symptoms in malignant neoplasms. Major modalities include surgical resection, radiation therapy, cytotoxic chemotherapy, endocrine/hormone therapy, targeted molecular inhibitors, immunotherapy (checkpoint inhibitors, CAR-T cells), and hematopoietic stem-cell transplantation, coordinated in multimodality protocols tailored to tumor histology, stage, molecular profile, and patient functional status.

Cancer Treatment-Induced Premature Menopause

The premature and often irreversible cessation of ovarian endocrine and reproductive function (iatrogenic premature ovarian insufficiency) resulting from gonadotoxic chemotherapy, pelvic radiotherapy, or surgical bilateral oophorectomy.

Alternate Names:
Treatment-Induced Early Menopause; Iatrogenic Premature Ovarian Insufficiency; Chemotherapy-Induced Menopause

Cancer Treatment-Related Bleeding

Bleeding or easy bruising that develops during cancer treatment, often because chemotherapy, radiation, or stem-cell transplantation lowers the platelet count. Signs may include nosebleeds, bleeding gums, unusual bruises, tiny red or purple skin spots, blood in urine or stool, or unusually heavy menstrual bleeding. Persistent or heavy bleeding can indicate significant blood loss or low platelet counts.

Cancer Treatments

Plural form; see *Cancer Treatment*.

Cancrum Oris

A rapidly destructive infection of the mouth and face, seen mainly in severely malnourished or medically vulnerable children. It begins with painful tissue death around the gums and can spread through the cheek and other facial tissues.

Candela

The international unit used to measure the brightness of a light source in a specified direction. It is a physical unit, not a measure of a medicine's light dose or the amount of light reaching tissue.

Candida

A group of yeasts that may normally live on the skin, in the mouth, or in the digestive and genital tracts. Overgrowth can cause mouth, genital, skin, or, in vulnerable people, bloodstream and organ infections.

Candida Albicans

The Candida species most often causing human infection. It can cause oral thrush, vaginal yeast infection, moist skin-fold rash, or serious bloodstream and organ infection in people with weakened defenses.

Candida Albicans Infection

Infection caused by Candida albicans. It may be limited to the mouth, vagina, or skin, or may invade the bloodstream and organs, especially in people who are hospitalized or have weakened immunity.

Candida Auris

A yeast that can live on skin without symptoms or cause bloodstream, wound, or ear infection. It often resists several antifungal medicines, spreads readily in health-care settings, and requires specialized testing and strict infection-control measures.

Candida Auris Infection

Infection or symptom-free colonization caused by Candida auris. Invasive infection may affect the blood or organs, especially in hospitalized or immunocompromised people; treatment is guided by susceptibility testing because resistance is common.

Candida Dubliniensis

A yeast related to Candida albicans that can live in the mouth and cause oral thrush or, rarely, invasive infection. It is more likely to cause disease when immune defenses are impaired.

Candida Esophagitis

Yeast infection of the esophagus, usually caused by Candida. It commonly causes painful or difficult swallowing and chest discomfort, especially in people with weakened immunity or after certain medicines.

Candida Glabrata

A Candida species that can cause genital, urinary, bloodstream, or other invasive infection. It may resist some commonly used antifungal medicines, so laboratory susceptibility testing can help guide treatment.

Candida Infection Of The Skin

A superficial yeast infection, often in warm, moist skin folds. It causes a red, itchy, sore rash that may have small separate spots around its edge and is more common with moisture, diabetes, obesity, or immune suppression.

Candidal Intertrigo

A Candida yeast infection in warm, moist skin folds such as the armpits, groin, under the breasts, or beneath an abdominal fold. It causes a red, moist, itchy or burning rash, sometimes with small spots at the edge.

Candidal Vaginitis

Alternate name; see *Vulvovaginal Candidiasis*.

Candidal Vulvovaginitis

Alternate index label; see *Vulvovaginal Candidiasis*.

Candida Parapsilosis

A Candida species that can cause bloodstream and catheter-related infection, especially in newborns, hospitalized people, and those receiving intravenous treatment. It may spread between patients through hands or contaminated equipment.

Candida Tropicalis

A Candida species that can cause mouth or genital infection and may invade the bloodstream or organs. Serious infection is more likely in people with neutropenia, cancer, or other immune impairment.

Candidemia

Candida yeast infection of the bloodstream. It can spread to organs and is more common with central lines, surgery, intensive care, recent antibiotics, or weakened immunity.

Candidiasis

Alternate name; see *Yeast Infection*.

Canefield Fever

An older name for leptospirosis, a bacterial infection acquired through water or soil contaminated with urine from infected animals. It can cause fever, headache, muscle pain, jaundice, kidney injury, meningitis, or bleeding.

Canicola Fever

A form of leptospirosis caused by a strain of Leptospira bacteria commonly carried by dogs. It may cause fever, headache, muscle aches, red eyes, kidney injury, or liver involvement after contact with infected urine or contaminated water.

Canine Teeth

The pointed teeth between the incisors and premolars. They help tear food and guide the jaws during biting and chewing.

Canker

Alternate name; see *Canker Sore*.

Canker Sore

A painful, shallow ulcer on the moist lining of the mouth, usually round or oval with a red border. It is not contagious and commonly heals within one to two weeks; persistent, severe, or unusual sores may have other causes.

Alternate Names:
Aphthous Ulcer

Canker Sores

Alternate name; see *Canker Sore*.

Cannabidiol

A cannabinoid from the cannabis plant that usually does not produce the "high" caused by THC. A purified form treats selected severe seizure disorders; other products vary in strength, purity, side effects, and medicine interactions.

Cannabinoid

A substance that acts on cannabinoid receptors or related signaling systems. Cannabinoids may come from plants, the body, or laboratories; effects can include pain relief, appetite changes, sedation, impaired memory, or intoxication.

Cannabinoid Hyperemesis Syndrome

A subtype of cyclic vomiting syndrome marked by recurrent episodes of severe nausea and vomiting, often with abdominal pain, in the setting of prolonged, frequent cannabis use. Hot baths or showers may temporarily ease symptoms; sustained cannabis abstinence is associated with their resolution.

Cannabinoid Receptor

A cell-surface protein, mainly CB1 or CB2, that responds to cannabinoids made by the body or found in cannabis and medicines. It helps regulate pain, appetite, mood, memory, immune activity, and inflammation.

Cannabinol

A cannabinoid formed as THC breaks down with age or exposure to air. It may have mild psychoactive effects, but its medical benefits and safety are less well established than those of some other cannabinoids.

Cannabis

A plant containing cannabinoids such as THC and CBD. Use can alter perception, memory, coordination, mood, and heart rate; it may have selected medical uses but can also cause dependence, anxiety, psychosis, or other harms.

Cannabis-Related Disorders

Clinically significant problems related to cannabis use, including intoxication, withdrawal, cannabis use disorder, and substance-induced psychiatric or medical effects.

Cannabis Use Disorder

A pattern of cannabis use that causes significant difficulty controlling use or problems at home, work, school, relationships, or health. Tolerance and withdrawal may occur, with irritability, anxiety, sleep problems, or reduced appetite after stopping.

Cannula

A thin hollow tube placed in a blood vessel, body cavity, or tissue to deliver medicines or fluids, remove material, measure pressure, provide oxygen, or allow access for another device.

Cannula Hub

The connector at the outer end of a cannula that attaches it to tubing, a syringe, or another device. It may include a port or valve for giving fluids, taking samples, or flushing the cannula.

Cannulation

Placement of a cannula into a blood vessel, body cavity, duct, or other passage. It provides access for giving fluids or medicines, removing material, monitoring, collecting samples, or performing a procedure.

Canola Oil

A vegetable oil relatively low in saturated fat and containing mostly monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats. Replacing solid fats with canola oil can support a heart-healthy eating pattern when total calories remain appropriate.

Canrenone

A metabolite related to spironolactone that blocks aldosterone's action. It promotes loss of sodium and water while reducing potassium loss and has been used in some countries for conditions involving fluid retention or excess aldosterone.

Cantharides

Preparations made from blister beetles that contain cantharidin, a powerful irritant. Swallowing or applying it can cause severe mouth, stomach, kidney, and urinary-tract injury and may be life-threatening.

Canthotomy

A surgical cut through the outer corner of the eyelids, usually performed urgently to relieve dangerous pressure around the eye and protect vision after severe orbital swelling or injury.

Canthus

The corner where the upper and lower eyelids meet. The inner canthus is beside the nose, and the outer canthus is toward the temple.

Cantlie Line

An imaginary line across the liver from the gallbladder to the large vein behind the liver. It follows the middle hepatic vein and marks the functional division between the right and left liver, including their blood supply and bile drainage.

Cantu Syndrome

A rare genetic condition, usually caused by an ABCC9 or KCNJ8 gene change. It may cause excessive hair growth, distinctive facial features, loose skin, enlarged bones, skeletal differences, and an enlarged or abnormal heart.

Capacitation

The final physiological maturation process that mammalian spermatozoa undergo within the female reproductive tract, involving the removal of glycoprotein coats and seminal plasma proteins from the acrosome, enabling the sperm to undergo the acrosome reaction and fertilize an oocyte.

Capacity

A person's ability, at a particular time, to understand information about a medical decision, appreciate how it applies to them, weigh the options, and communicate a choice.

Capacity And Competence

Capacity is the clinical ability to make a specific decision by understanding, using, and communicating relevant information. Competence is a legal determination; the two terms are related but not interchangeable.

Capecitabine

An oral chemotherapy medicine that the body converts to fluorouracil, which interferes with cancer-cell DNA production. It is used for selected cancers and can cause diarrhea, mouth sores, hand-foot syndrome, low blood counts, or heart problems.

Capgras Delusion

A psychiatric misidentification syndrome in which an individual maintains a fixed, unshakeable delusion that a close relative, spouse, or companion has been replaced by an identical-looking imposter, double, or clone. Hypothesized to stem from a neuroanatomical disconnection between visual facial recognition pathways in the fusiform gyrus and emotional familiarity processing in the amygdala.

Alternate Names:
Capgras Syndrome; Illusion of Doubles

Capgras Syndrome

A fixed false belief that someone familiar has been replaced by an identical impostor. It may occur with psychotic illness, dementia, brain injury, seizures, or other neurologic disorders and needs clinical assessment.

Capillaria

A group of parasitic roundworms. Different species can cause intestinal infection, liver disease, or infection of other tissues; symptoms and treatment depend on the species and affected organ.

Capillaria Philippinensis

A parasitic roundworm acquired by eating raw or undercooked freshwater fish. It infects the intestine and can cause persistent watery diarrhea, abdominal pain, weight loss, poor absorption of nutrients, and loss of blood proteins.

Capillaroscopy

Examination of tiny blood vessels, usually in the skin beside a fingernail, with magnification. It can show widened or missing vessels, bleeding, and abnormal patterns that support evaluation of connective-tissue and small-vessel disease.

Capillary

The smallest type of blood vessel, forming networks that connect arterioles with venules. Its thin wall allows exchange of oxygen, nutrients, fluid, and waste between blood and tissues.

Alternate Names:
Capillaries

Capillary Bed

A network of capillaries within a tissue that connects small arteries to small veins. It provides a large surface for exchange of oxygen, carbon dioxide, nutrients, hormones, fluid, and waste.

Capillary Blood Gas

A test of blood acidity and carbon dioxide using a small sample from a heel or finger. It is often used in babies and children when an arterial sample is difficult; oxygen results may not match an arterial blood gas.

Alternate Names:
CBG

Capillary Electrophoresis

A laboratory method that separates charged molecules in a very thin tube using an electric field. It can analyze proteins, medicines, DNA, or other substances in a sample, depending on the test.

Capillary Exchange

The movement of oxygen, carbon dioxide, nutrients, fluid, hormones, and waste between blood in capillaries and nearby tissues.

Capillary Hemangioma

Older name; see *Infantile Hemangioma*.

Capillary Leak Syndrome

A condition in which fluid and proteins escape from small blood vessels into surrounding tissues. It can cause sudden swelling, low blood pressure, thickened blood, shock, and organ failure; severe infection, medicines, immune disease, or rare unexplained episodes may trigger it.

Capillary Malformation

A congenital difference in small skin blood vessels that produces a flat pink, red, or violaceous patch, such as a port-wine stain. It usually persists and may darken or thicken over time; location and associated findings determine whether eye, brain, or other specialist evaluation is needed.

Capillary Microscope

A microscope used to magnify tiny blood vessels, especially those beside the fingernails. It helps assess vessel shape, size, bleeding, and areas without vessels in some circulation and connective-tissue disorders.

Capillary Nail Refill Test

A bedside check of circulation in which a nail bed is pressed until it turns pale and the time for color to return is observed. Temperature, lighting, age, skin color, shock, and vascular disease affect the result, so it is not used alone.

Capillary Permeability

How easily fluid and dissolved substances pass through the walls of small blood vessels. Increased permeability can allow extra fluid and proteins to enter nearby tissues and cause swelling.

Capillary Plasma

The liquid component of blood obtained from small vessels in skin or tissue, containing water, electrolytes, proteins, hormones, nutrients, and waste products.

Capillary Refill

A bedside assessment of peripheral perfusion performed by briefly pressing a nail bed or skin and measuring the time for normal color to return. De-

layed refill may indicate poor circulation, shock, hypothermia, or vascular disease.

Capillary Refill Time

The number of seconds it takes for color to return to a fingertip or nail bed after pressure blanches the skin and is released. A return time longer than about 2 seconds is commonly treated as prolonged, but thresholds vary with age and measurement site; skin temperature and technique also affect the result. Prolonged refill may indicate reduced blood flow to the extremities.

Capillary Sample

A small blood specimen obtained by puncturing the skin, usually a finger or heel, for bedside glucose, hemoglobin, newborn screening, or other point-of-care tests.

Capillary Vessel

A microscopic vessel with a thin endothelial wall where blood exchanges oxygen, carbon dioxide, nutrients, fluid, and waste with surrounding tissue.

Capitate

The largest wrist bone, located centrally in the distal row of carpal bones. It connects with several other wrist bones and the third metacarpal, helps transmit force through the wrist, and can rarely develop blood-supply loss after fracture.

Capitation

A health-care payment arrangement in which a clinician or organization receives a fixed amount per enrolled person for specified services over a set period, whether or not that person uses the services.

Caplan's Syndrome

A lung disorder combining rheumatoid arthritis with pneumoconiosis caused by long-term inhalation of coal or mineral dust. It produces multiple lung nodules and may cause cough or breathing difficulty.

Caplan Syndrome

The coexistence of rheumatoid arthritis with occupational pneumoconiosis (most commonly coal workers' pneumoconiosis or silicosis), characterized by the development of multiple discrete, round, peripheral pulmonary nodules measuring 0.5 to 5 centimeters on chest radiography. Histologically, the nodules resemble enlarged rheumatoid nodules with central necrotic debris surrounded by chronic inflammatory cells and dust-laden macrophages.

Alternate Names:
Rheumatoid Pneumoconiosis; Silicoarthritis

Capnocytophaga

A group of bacteria found mainly in the mouths of dogs, cats, and people. Some species can cause serious human infection after animal bites or scratches, especially in people without a functioning spleen or with weakened immunity.

Capnocytophaga Canimorsus

A bacterium commonly found in the mouths of dogs and cats. It can cause rapidly severe bloodstream infection, meningitis, or skin infection after a bite or scratch, especially in older adults or people without a functioning spleen or with weakened immunity.

Capnocytophaga Infection

Infection caused by Capnocytophaga bacteria, often after a dog or cat bite, scratch, or contact with animal saliva. It may cause a wound infection, fever, bloodstream infection, or meningitis, with greatest risk in people with impaired immunity or no spleen.

Capnocytophaga Ochracea

A bacterium found mainly in the human mouth and associated with dental plaque and gum disease. Infection outside the mouth is uncommon but can occur when immune defenses are severely weakened.

Capnograph

A monitor that measures and displays carbon dioxide in exhaled air, often showing both the end-tidal value and a waveform. It is used to assess ventilation and to monitor selected patients during anesthesia, sedation, transport, or resuscitation.

Capnography

Continuous measurement and display of carbon dioxide in exhaled air. The waveform and end-tidal value help assess breathing, airway blockage, circulation, and correct placement of a breathing tube during anesthesia, sedation, or emergency care.

Caps

A prescription abbreviation for capsules, oral medicines enclosed in a shell that dissolves in the digestive tract. Abbreviations can be misread, so complete dosage-form wording is safer on prescriptions.

Capsaicin

The substance that makes chili peppers feel hot. Applied in controlled amounts to the skin, it can reduce some nerve and joint pains by temporarily lowering pain signaling; it commonly causes initial burning or redness.

Capsid

The protein shell surrounding a virus's genetic material. It protects the genome and helps the virus attach to and enter host cells; its structure influences which cells can be infected and how the immune system responds.

Capsid Proteins

Proteins that assemble around a virus's genetic material to form its protective shell. Some also help the virus attach to and enter cells and are recognized by the immune system.

Capsular Contracture

Abnormal tightening and hardening of scar tissue around an implanted device, especially a breast implant. It may make the area firm, painful, distorted, or displaced and sometimes requires corrective surgery.

Capsular Warning Syndrome

A clinical syndrome characterized by recurrent, stereotyped episodes of transient focal motor or sensory deficits affecting the face, arm, and leg without cortical signs (such as aphasia or visual neglect). Occurring repeatedly within a 24- to 72-hour window, it indicates impending lacunar infarction of the internal capsule due to branch atheromatous disease of a lenticulostriate artery.

Alternate Names:
Internal Capsule Warning Syndrome; Fluctuating Lacunar TIA

Capsule

A protective covering around an organ, joint, or other structure, or an oral medicine enclosed in a dissolvable shell. The exact meaning depends on whether the term is used in anatomy or pharmacology.

Capsulectomy

Surgical removal of some or all of the scar-tissue capsule around an organ, implant, or other structure. It may be performed for painful tightening, infection, abnormal tissue, or revision of a reconstruction.

Capsule Endoscope

A swallowable capsule containing a tiny camera and transmitter. As it travels through the digestive tract, it sends images, especially of the small intestine, where conventional endoscopes may not reach easily.

Capsule Endoscopy

A test in which a person swallows a small wireless camera that takes pictures of the digestive tract, especially the small intestine. The capsule usually passes naturally but can become stuck where the bowel is narrowed.

Capsule Of Glisson

The layer of connective tissue surrounding the liver. It extends inward around the liver's blood vessels, bile ducts, and nerves and helps support and protect these structures.

Capsule Of Tenon

A thin connective-tissue sheath surrounding the eyeball and separating it from the fat of the eye socket. It allows smooth eye movement and creates a space used for some eye injections and operations.

Capsulotomy

A procedure that makes an opening in a capsule. In the eye, a laser may open a cloudy capsule after cataract surgery; in other surgery, a capsule around an implant or joint may be opened to reduce tightness. The method and risks depend on the body part.

Captopril

An angiotensin-converting enzyme inhibitor used for high blood pressure, heart failure, and some kidney problems. It can cause cough, high potassium, low blood pressure, or swelling.

Captopril Renal Scan

A kidney imaging test using a radioactive tracer before and after captopril. It compares kidney blood flow and function and may help evaluate high blood pressure caused by narrowing of a kidney artery.

Caput Medusae

Enlarged veins spreading out from the navel, caused by increased pressure in the portal vein system, usually from liver disease. They are a physical sign of abdominal collateral circulation rather than a disease by themselves.

Caput Succedaneum

Soft swelling of a newborn's scalp caused by pressure during labor. It can cross the skull's suture lines and usually disappears within hours to a few days; rapidly enlarging swelling or pallor may indicate other complications.

Carbachol

A medicine that mimics acetylcholine and stimulates muscarinic receptors. In selected eye procedures, it constricts the pupil and can lower pressure inside the eye; effects may include sweating, slow heartbeat, or breathing problems.

Carbamate

A chemical group found in some medicines and pesticides. Carbamate insecticides can temporarily block acetylcholinesterase, causing excess nerve activity with sweating, salivation, vomiting, weakness, wheezing, or seizures.

Carbamazepine

A medicine used for focal seizures, trigeminal neuralgia, and selected bipolar disorder. Important risks include severe skin reactions, low blood counts, liver injury, low sodium, dizziness, and interactions with many other medicines.

Carbamazepine Toxicity

Overdose causing drowsiness, ataxia, nystagmus, anticholinergic effects, hypotension, seizures, coma, or sodium-channel-mediated QRS widening and dysrhythmias. Serial drug levels and ECGs help guide care; activated charcoal, sodium bicarbonate for cardiotoxicity, and hemodialysis may be used in severe cases.

Carbamide

Another name for urea, a waste product made when the body breaks down protein and removed mainly by the kidneys. Urea is also used in some skin creams to soften and hydrate thick or dry skin.

Carbamoyl Phosphate Synthetase Deficiency

An inherited urea-cycle disorder caused by deficient carbamoyl phosphate synthetase I. The liver cannot efficiently convert ammonia into urea, so hyperammonemia may cause poor feeding, vomiting, sleepiness, seizures, coma, or developmental injury.

Carbapenem

A group of powerful beta-lactam antibiotics that kill bacteria by blocking construction of their cell wall. They are reserved mainly for serious infections because resistance and important side effects can limit treatment choices.

Carbapenem-Resistant Enterobacteriaceae

Alternate name; see *CRE Infection*.

Carbapenem-Resistant

Enterobacteriaceae Infection

Alternate name; see *CRE Infection*.

Carbapenem-Resistant Organisms

Bacteria that cannot be reliably treated with carbapenem antibiotics, often because they produce enzymes that destroy these medicines. They can cause difficult infections and spread in health-care settings, where strict infection control is important.

Carbaryl

A carbamate insecticide that temporarily blocks acetylcholinesterase. Substantial exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle weakness, wheezing, seizures, or breathing failure.

Carbidopa

A medicine given with levodopa for Parkinson disease. It blocks conversion of levodopa to dopamine outside the brain, allowing more levodopa to reach the brain and reducing nausea, vomiting, and low blood pressure.

Carbimazole

An antithyroid medicine that the body converts to methimazole. It reduces production of thyroid hormones and can rarely cause dangerously low white-cell counts or liver injury.

Carbofuran

A highly toxic carbamate pesticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase. Ingestion, inhalation, or skin exposure can rapidly cause sweating, vomiting, muscle weakness, seizures, breathing failure, and death.

Carbohydrate

An essential nutrient that provides the body's main source of cellular energy. Consisting of carbon, hydrogen, and oxygen, carbohydrates include sugars (simple carbohydrates like glucose and fructose) and starches and fibers (complex carbohydrates found in grains, legumes, and vegetables). The body breaks down most digestible carbohydrates into glucose, which fuels the brain, muscles, and organs.

Carbohydrate Counting

A way to plan meals by estimating the grams of carbohydrate in food. People using insulin may match their insulin dose to the amount eaten; accurate reading of food labels and advice from a diabetes team are important.

Carbohydrate Metabolism

The processes cells use to break down, store, and make sugars. These processes provide energy and help keep blood glucose stable; problems can occur in diabetes and inherited disorders of sugar storage.

Carbohydrates

Plural form; see *Carbohydrate*.

Carbolic Acid

Phenol, a chemical once used as a surgical antiseptic and still found in some industrial products. It kills microorganisms by damaging proteins and cell membranes but can severely burn skin, eyes, and internal organs.

Alternate Names:
Phenol

Carbolic Acid Poisoning

Exposure to phenol, a corrosive and systemically toxic chemical that can cause burns, altered consciousness, metabolic acidosis, and organ injury.

Carbon

A chemical element forming the backbone of organic molecules such as carbohydrates, fats, proteins, and nucleic acids.

Carbonate

A chemical form of carbon dioxide found in minerals and body fluids. Carbonate salts are used in some antacids and supplements; their effects, absorption, and risks depend on the particular salt.

Carbon Dioxide

A gas produced when cells use energy and removed mainly by the lungs during exhalation. The body controls its blood level through breathing; excess

can cause headache, confusion, drowsiness, or respiratory failure.

Carbon Dioxide Absorber

A device in some anaesthesia breathing systems that removes carbon dioxide from exhaled air. It allows selected gases to be reused while helping prevent carbon-dioxide build-up during controlled breathing.

Carbon Dioxide Transport

The movement of carbon dioxide from body tissues to the lungs. Blood carries it dissolved in plasma, attached to haemoglobin, and mainly as bicarbonate; the lungs remove it during exhalation.

Carbonic Anhydrase Inhibitors

Medicines that block carbonic anhydrase, an enzyme involved in fluid and acid balance. They reduce fluid production in the eye to lower eye pressure and have selected uses for swelling, seizures, or metabolic disorders.

Carbon Ion Therapy

A form of particle radiation treatment that uses carbon ions to damage tumor DNA. It may deliver concentrated energy and has higher biological effectiveness than conventional X-rays for some tumors, but availability is limited.

Carbon Monoxide

A colorless, odorless gas that binds hemoglobin and prevents blood from delivering enough oxygen. Poisoning may cause headache, dizziness, nausea, confusion, collapse, or death.

Carbon Monoxide Poisoning

A life-threatening condition caused by inhaling carbon monoxide, an odorless, colorless gas. When inhaled, it binds tightly to hemoglobin in red blood cells, displacing oxygen and preventing the blood from delivering oxygen to the body's tissues and vital organs. Symptoms include headache, dizziness, nausea, confusion, weakness, chest pain, and loss of consciousness.

Carbon Monoxide Toxicity

Tissue hypoxia caused by inhaled carbon monoxide binding hemoglobin and impairing cellular oxygen use. Headache, dizziness, nausea, confusion, syncope, myocardial ischemia, seizures, or coma may occur; pulse oximetry can be misleading, so co-oximetry and exposure history are important. Give 100% oxygen and consider hyperbaric therapy for selected severe cases.

Carbon Tetrachloride

A toxic industrial solvent that can damage the liver and kidneys when swallowed or inhaled.

Carbophenothion

An organophosphate insecticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase. Significant exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, muscle weakness, confusion, seizures, breathing failure, and death.

Carboplatin

A platinum chemotherapy medicine that damages cancer-cell DNA and prevents it from being copied. It can lower blood counts, especially platelets, and may cause nausea, anemia, kidney effects, nerve symptoms, or allergic reactions.

Carboprost

A prostaglandin medicine that strongly contracts the uterus. It is used in selected cases of severe bleeding after childbirth and for some pregnancy-related procedures; it can cause diarrhea, vomiting, fever, and dangerous airway tightening in people with asthma.

Carbosulfan

A carbamate insecticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase and overstimulates nerves. Exposure can cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle weakness, wheezing, seizures, or breathing failure.

Carboxyhaemoglobin

Hemoglobin bound to carbon monoxide. This reduces the blood's ability to carry and release oxygen; an increased level supports recent carbon-monoxide

exposure, and levels vary with symptoms and timing.

Carboxyhemoglobin

A compound formed when carbon monoxide binds to hemoglobin. It prevents hemoglobin from carrying and releasing oxygen normally, causing headache, dizziness, confusion, collapse, or death in severe poisoning.

Carboxyhemoglobinemia

An abnormally high level of carboxyhemoglobin in the blood after carbon-monoxide exposure. It reduces oxygen delivery and may cause headache, nausea, confusion, fainting, heart injury, brain injury, or death.

Carboxylesterase

An enzyme that breaks ester bonds in medicines, toxins, and natural fats. Differences in its activity can change how quickly some substances are broken down and can affect their effects, interactions, or toxicity.

Carboxyl Group

A chemical group containing carbon, oxygen, and hydrogen that gives many molecules acidic properties. It is found in amino acids, fatty acids, and numerous medicines and metabolic compounds.

Carboxylic Acid

An organic compound containing a carboxyl group, which gives it acidic properties. Many important fatty acids, amino-acid products, and substances involved in metabolism are carboxylic acids.

Carboxy-Lyases

Enzymes that break a carbon-carbon bond and release carbon dioxide. They participate in many biochemical reactions, including processes that make or break down amino acids and other molecules.

Carboxypeptidase H

An enzyme inside cells that helps turn newly made precursor proteins into active hormones and nerve-signalling substances by trimming amino acids from one end.

Carbuncle

A group of connected boils, usually caused by Staphylococcus aureus, forming a painful swollen area with several pus-draining openings. Fever may occur, and risk is increased by diabetes or a weakened immune system.

Carbuncles and Boils

Alternate index label; see *Boils and Carbuncles*.

Carcinoembryonal Antigen

Another name for carcinoembryonic antigen, or CEA, a blood marker that may rise in colorectal and other cancers. It can also increase for noncancerous reasons and is not suitable for general cancer screening.

Carcinoembryonic Antigen

A protein measured in blood that may be increased in colorectal and some other cancers. It can also rise with smoking, liver disease, bowel inflammation, or other noncancerous conditions, so it is mainly used to monitor selected known cancers rather than to screen for cancer.

Carcinoembryonic Antigen Tumor Marker

Carcinoembryonic antigen, a substance measured mainly in blood to help monitor some colorectal and other cancers. Levels can also rise from smoking or noncancerous conditions, so CEA cannot diagnose cancer by itself.

Carcinogen

A substance, form of radiation, or infection that can cause cancer by damaging cells or changing how they grow. Risk depends on the type and amount of exposure.

Carcinogenesis

The multistep process by which normal cells acquire changes that allow uncontrolled growth and become

cancer. Changes may arise from inherited traits, random errors, infections, tobacco, radiation, chemicals, or other exposures and often accumulate over time.

Carcinogenic

Capable of causing or promoting cancer by damaging genetic material or altering how cells grow, divide, repair themselves, or avoid cell death.

Carcinoid

A usually slow-growing neuroendocrine tumor that can arise in the digestive tract, appendix, or lungs. Some release hormones or other substances that cause flushing, diarrhea, wheezing, or heart-valve disease.

Carcinoid Flushing

Sudden, transient cutaneous erythema and warmth, predominantly affecting the face, neck, and upper chest, provoked by systemic release of serotonin, bradykinin, and histamine from a metastatic neuroendocrine (carcinoid) tumor with hepatic metastases.

Alternate Names:
Carcinoid Flush

Carcinoid Heart Disease

Damage to the inner lining and valves of the heart caused by hormone-like substances released by a neuroendocrine tumor. It mainly affects the tricuspid and pulmonary valves and can lead to right-sided heart failure.

Carcinoid Syndrome

A group of symptoms caused by serotonin and other substances released into the blood by some neuroendocrine tumors. It usually occurs when a tumor has spread to the liver, but can occur without liver spread in some cases. Symptoms may include facial flushing, diarrhea, wheezing, and a fast heartbeat; long-term exposure can damage heart valves.

Carcinoid Tumor

A well-differentiated neuroendocrine tumor arising from enterochromaffin (Kulchitsky) cells, most commonly within the gastrointestinal tract (ileum, appendix, rectum) or bronchopulmonary system. Often secretes vasoactive peptides and amines, particularly serotonin (5-HT), bradykinin, and prostaglandins. Hepatic metastasis or primary bronchial drainage bypasses liver first-pass metabolism, leading to carcinoid syndrome characterized by paroxysmal cutaneous flushing, secretory diarrhea, bronchospasm, and carcinoid heart disease (fibrotic endocardial plaques causing tricuspid regurgitation and pulmonary stenosis). Diagnostic evaluation includes 24-hour urinary 5-hydroxyindoleacetic acid (5-HIAA), serum chromogranin A, and somatostatin-receptor imaging (e.g., Ga-68 DOTATATE PET-CT).

Alternate Names:
Neuroendocrine Tumors (NETs); Carcinoid Neoplasms; Carcinoid Tumors

Carcinoid Tumors

Plural form; see *Carcinoid Tumor*.

Carcinoma

A cancer that begins in epithelial cells, which cover body surfaces and line organs and glands. Common types include adenocarcinoma, squamous-cell carcinoma, basal-cell carcinoma, and urothelial carcinoma; behavior depends on site and cell features.

Carcinoma En Cuirasse

An advanced form of breast cancer in which cancer cells spread through lymphatic vessels in the skin, causing widespread hardening and thickening that can make the chest wall resemble armor.

Carcinoma Erysipeloides

Spread of an internal cancer through lymph vessels in the skin, producing a red, firm, sharply outlined area that can resemble the infection erysipelas. It most often occurs with cancers of the breast or digestive tract.

Carcinoma In Situ

A group of abnormal cells that look like cancer cells but remain where they first formed. They have not grown into nearby tissue. Some types may later

grow into surrounding tissue and become invasive cancer. In some cancers, carcinoma in situ is also called stage 0 disease.

Alternate Names:
CIS

Carcinoma Of Unknown Primary

A heterogeneous group of biopsy-confirmed metastatic epithelial malignancies in which the primary anatomical site remains unidentified despite comprehensive standardized diagnostic evaluation (detailed history, thorough clinical examination, whole-body contrast CT or PET-CT, endoscopies, and serum tumor markers). Accounts for approximately 3–5% of all invasive cancers. Diagnostic workup hinges on immunohistochemistry (IHC) profiling of the biopsy specimen: cytokeratin 7 (CK7) and cytokeratin 20 (CK20) expression patterns, alongside specific lineage markers including thyroid transcription factor-1 (TTF-1) for lung/thyroid, CDX2 for gastrointestinal, and GATA3 or mammaglobin for breast neoplasms. Favorable subsets (e.g., poorly differentiated neuroendocrine carcinoma, axillary lymphadenopathy in women, isolated cervical adenopathy, or peritoneal carcinomatosis) receive site-specific curative-intent therapies; unfavorable subsets receive empiric broad-spectrum platinum- or taxane-based systemic chemotherapy or molecularly targeted therapies guided by comprehensive genomic profiling.

Alternate Names:
CUP; Cancer Of Unknown Primary; Occult Primary Malignancy

Carcinomatosis

Widespread spread of carcinoma to multiple surfaces or organs, often along the lining of the abdomen, chest, or other body cavities. It usually indicates advanced cancer and may cause fluid buildup, pain, bowel problems, or breathing difficulty.

Carcinosarcoma

An uncommon cancer containing both gland- or surface-lining cancer cells and connective-tissue cancer cells. It most often begins in the uterus, tends to grow aggressively, and is diagnosed by examining a tissue sample.

Cardia

The upper part of the stomach surrounding the opening where the esophagus enters. It helps receive swallowed food and can be affected by reflux, inflammation, hiatal hernia, or stomach cancer.

Cardiac

Relating to the heart. The word may describe the heart muscle, chambers, valves, electrical system, blood supply, rhythm, or diseases such as coronary disease, cardiomyopathy, and heart failure; in "cardia," it instead refers to the upper stomach.

Alternate Names:
Heart-Related; Cardiac-Related

Cardiac Ablation

A procedure that uses heat, cold, or another form of energy to create small scars in heart tissue that produces or conducts abnormal electrical signals. The scars block those signals and can treat certain abnormal heart rhythms.

Cardiac Ablation Procedures

Procedures that use heat, cold, or another energy source to treat heart-rhythm disorders by creating controlled scars that block abnormal electrical signals. Risks include bleeding, blood-vessel injury, recurrence, and damage to nearby heart structures.

Cardiac Allograft

A donor heart transplanted into another person, usually for end-stage heart failure. Lifelong immune-suppressing treatment is needed to reduce rejection; complications include infection, rejection, coronary-vessel disease, cancer, and graft failure.

Cardiac Allograft Vasculopathy

Progressive narrowing of the heart's blood vessels after transplantation caused by abnormal thickening of their inner walls. It may silently reduce blood flow and cause graft failure, rhythm problems, heart attack, or sudden death.

Cardiac Amyloidosis

A restrictive heart-muscle disease caused by extracellular deposits of amyloid fibrils, formed from misfolded proteins. The main types are immunoglobulin light-chain (AL) and transthyretin (ATTR) amyloidosis; deposits stiffen the heart and impair filling, and may also affect its electrical system. Symptoms can include breathlessness, swelling, abnormal heart rhythms, and heart failure.

Cardiac Amyloidosis Diagnosis

Evaluation combines symptoms, examination, blood and urine tests, heart imaging, and sometimes tissue biopsy. Specialized nuclear imaging may support transthyretin amyloidosis only after testing has excluded light-chain amyloidosis.

Cardiac Amyloidosis Staging

Classification of disease severity and likely outcome using clinical findings, heart imaging, and blood tests. Different staging systems apply to light-chain and transthyretin amyloidosis, and higher stages generally indicate more advanced disease.

Cardiac Arrest

Sudden loss of effective heart function, causing unresponsiveness and absent or abnormal breathing. It results from a severe electrical or mechanical problem and stops blood flow to the brain and other organs; without resuscitation, it is fatal.

Alternate Names:
Cardiopulmonary Arrest; Circulatory Arrest; Sudden Cardiac Arrest

Cardiac Arrhythmia

Alternate name; see *Arrhythmia*.

Cardiac Arrhythmias

Abnormal heart rates or rhythms caused by problems forming or conducting electrical impulses. They include rhythms that are too fast, too slow, or irregular and may cause palpitations, dizziness, fainting, or no symptoms.

Cardiac Axis

The average direction in which the heart's lower chambers become electrically activated, estimated from an electrocardiogram. A leftward or rightward shift may reflect normal variation or heart, conduction, or lung disease.

Cardiac Biomarkers

Substances measured in blood to detect or assess heart-muscle injury. Troponin is the preferred marker; levels can also rise in other conditions and vary with symptoms, electrocardiography, imaging, and serial measurements.

Cardiac Cachexia

Severe unintentional loss of weight and muscle associated with advanced heart failure or other serious heart disease. It can cause weakness and reduced function and reflects inflammation, altered metabolism, poor appetite, and increased nutritional needs.

Cardiac Catheter

A thin flexible tube inserted through a blood vessel and guided to the heart. It can measure pressures, take blood samples, inject contrast for imaging, or deliver treatment.

Cardiac Catheterization

A procedure in which thin tubes are guided through a blood vessel to the heart to measure pressures, assess oxygen levels, inject contrast, image coronary arteries, or perform treatment. Possible risks include bleeding, rhythm problems, vessel injury, and kidney effects.

Cardiac Cirrhosis

Alternate name; see *Congestive Hepatopathy*.

Cardiac Conduction System

Specialized heart tissue that creates and carries electrical signals so the chambers contract in the correct order. It includes the sinoatrial node, atrioventricular node, bundle of His, bundle branches, and Purkinje fibers.

Cardiac Contractility

The strength of heart-muscle contraction at a given level of filling and resistance. It affects how much blood the heart can pump with each beat.

Cardiac CT

Computed-tomography imaging of the heart and nearby blood vessels. Depending on the protocol, it can assess coronary calcium, coronary narrowing, heart structure, valves, and selected aspects of heart function.

Cardiac CT Angiography

A noninvasive scan using contrast and computed tomography to show the coronary arteries and heart structures. It is useful for assessing selected people with chest pain and can show narrowing, plaque, and coronary calcium.

Cardiac Cycle

The events in one complete heartbeat. During diastole the heart chambers relax and fill with blood; during systole the ventricles contract and pump blood into the lungs and the rest of the body.

Cardiac Defibrillation

Delivery of an electrical shock to interrupt ventricular fibrillation or pulseless ventricular tachycardia during cardiac arrest. It is used with cardiopulmonary resuscitation as part of resuscitation for these shockable rhythms.

Cardiac Device Infections

Infection involving a pacemaker, implantable defibrillator, its pocket, or a lead. It may cause redness, pain, drainage, fever, bloodstream infection, or infection of the heart lining and often requires antibiotics and removal of infected hardware.

Cardiac Diet

A general term for an eating pattern intended to reduce cardiovascular risk, commonly emphasizing vegetables, fruits, whole grains, legumes, nuts, and unsaturated fats while limiting excess sodium and saturated or trans fats. It is not a single standardized diet, and individual nutritional needs vary.

Cardiac Electrophysiology Study

An electrophysiology study in which thin tubes are placed through a blood vessel into the heart to record and stimulate its electrical activity. It helps find the cause of some abnormal rhythms or unexplained fainting.

Cardiac Enzymes

Older term; see *Cardiac Biomarkers*.

Cardiac Event Monitors

Portable devices that record or send an electrocardiogram when symptoms occur or at planned times. They help detect intermittent abnormal rhythms that may be missed during a short clinic ECG.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Event Monitor; Ambulatory ECG

Cardiac Failure

Alternate name; see *Heart Failure*.

Cardiac Fibroma

A rare noncancerous tumor made of fibrous tissue in the heart, usually in a ventricle or septum. It may obstruct blood flow, interfere with electrical signals, or cause rhythm problems and heart failure.

Cardiac Gated SPECT

A heart scan using a small radioactive tracer while images are synchronized with the heartbeat. It can assess blood flow to heart muscle, pumping strength, wall movement, and areas that are damaged or still viable.

Cardiac Glycoside

A medicine or plant substance that can strengthen heart contraction and slow electrical conduction through the heart. Digoxin is the main clinical example; the safe dose is narrow and toxicity can cause dangerous rhythms.

Cardiac Glycoside Overdose

Toxic exposure to a cardiac glycoside such as digoxin. It may cause nausea, vomiting, confusion, visual changes, slow or fast abnormal rhythms, high potas-

sium, seizures, or cardiac arrest.

Cardiac Glycoside Plant Poisoning

Poisoning from plants such as oleander or foxglove that contain cardiac glycosides. It can cause nausea, vomiting, visual changes, slow heart rate, heart block, dangerous rhythms, and high blood potassium.

Cardiac Hemangioma

A rare noncancerous tumor made of blood-vessel tissue in or around the heart. Many cause no symptoms, but a large or strategically located tumor may obstruct flow, disturb rhythm, or cause fluid around the heart.

Cardiac Imaging Tests

Tests that show the heart's structure, movement, blood flow, or tissue. They include echocardiography, CT, MRI, and nuclear scans; the appropriate test depends on symptoms, the suspected condition, kidney function, and the clinical question.

Cardiac Index

The amount of blood the heart pumps each minute adjusted for body size. It helps assess pumping function, especially in seriously ill people; blood pressure, symptoms, organ function, and overall clinical status affect its significance.

Cardiac Intravascular Ultrasound

An ultrasound probe on a catheter that creates cross-sectional images from inside a coronary artery. It helps measure plaque, vessel size, narrowing, tears, calcium, and stent expansion during selected procedures.

Cardiac Ischemia

Alternate name; see *Myocardial Ischemia*.

Cardiac Markers

Blood tests used to detect myocardial injury or cardiac stress, including troponin, creatine kinase-MB, and natriuretic peptides. Results are interpreted with symptoms, electrocardiography, imaging, timing, and other causes of abnormal values.

Cardiac Metastases

Cancer that has spread to the heart or its surrounding tissues from another organ. Lung and breast cancers, melanoma, lymphoma, and kidney cancer are common sources; spread may cause fluid around the heart, obstruction, rhythm problems, or heart failure.

Cardiac MRI

Magnetic-resonance imaging that shows heart structure, pumping, blood flow, scar, swelling, infiltrative disease, and congenital abnormalities without x-rays. Contrast may be avoided or used cautiously in selected people with severe kidney disease.

Cardiac Muscle

Involuntary muscle that forms the myocardium, the main muscular layer of the heart. Its cells are electrically connected so the chambers contract in a coordinated way to pump blood.

Cardiac Myocyte

A specialized, striated muscle cell of the myocardium interconnected by intercalated discs containing desmosomes and gap junctions for synchronized electrical and mechanical coupling. Excitation-contraction coupling is mediated by calcium-induced calcium release via L-type calcium channels and ryanodine receptors. Irreversible injury or necrosis (as in acute myocardial infarction) disrupts contractile function and causes release of intracellular cardiac biomarkers (cardiac troponins I and T, CK-MB) into the circulation.

Cardiac Myocytes

Plural form; see *Cardiac Myocyte*.

Cardiac Myxoma

The most common primary noncancerous tumor of the heart, usually arising in the left atrium. It can obstruct blood flow, cause breathlessness or constitutional symptoms, or release clots; surgical removal is usually recommended.

Cardiac Output

The volume of blood pumped by the heart each minute. It depends mainly on heart rate and stroke volume, the amount ejected with each beat, and helps indicate whether circulation is adequate.

Cardiac Output Measurement

Measurement of blood pumped by the heart each minute using methods such as echocardiography, a pulmonary-artery catheter, oxygen-consumption calculations, or noninvasive monitors. The method's accuracy depends on the patient and testing conditions.

Cardiac Pacemaker

Alternate name; see *Pacemaker*.

Cardiac Pacemaker Types

Single-chamber pacemakers stimulate one heart chamber; dual-chamber devices coordinate the atrium and ventricle; biventricular or resynchronization devices stimulate both ventricles to improve timing in selected heart-failure patients.

Cardiac Pacemaker Implantation

The surgical placement of an electronic pulse generator and transvenous leads under the skin of the chest to regulate bradycardia or irregular heart rhythms; see *Pacemaker Implantation* and *Cardiac Pacemaker*.

Cardiac Perforation

A hole or tear through the heart wall, sometimes caused by injury or a medical procedure. It can cause bleeding around the heart, cardiac tamponade, shock, and death.

Cardiac PET

A nuclear-imaging test using a positron-emitting tracer to assess heart-muscle blood flow, metabolism, and living or scarred tissue. Selected tracers can also help evaluate inflammation or infiltrative heart disease.

Cardiac PET Imaging

Positron-emission tomography using a radioactive tracer to measure blood flow and metabolism in heart muscle. It can quantify blood flow and help distinguish living from scarred tissue, but availability, radiation exposure, and tracer choice affect its use.

Cardiac Power Output

A measure combining blood pressure and cardiac output to estimate how effectively the heart is pumping. It is useful in severe heart failure or cardiogenic shock, but clinicians interpret it with examination findings, organ function, and other circulation measurements.

Alternate Names:
CPO

Cardiac Radiation Injury

Damage to the heart or its blood vessels that may appear months or years after radiation to the chest. It can cause inflammation or scarring around the heart, coronary disease, valve disease, heart-muscle weakness, or rhythm and conduction problems.

Cardiac Radionuclide Imaging

Heart imaging performed after a small radioactive tracer is given, usually with SPECT or PET. It can assess blood flow, metabolism, living or scarred heart muscle, inflammation, and, when synchronized with the heartbeat, pumping function.

Cardiac Rehabilitation

A medically supervised program after conditions such as heart attack, coronary procedures, bypass surgery, or heart failure. It combines gradual exercise, education, risk-factor reduction, medicine support, nutrition, and emotional care to improve recovery and reduce future risk.

Cardiac Rehabilitation Phases

Stages used to describe cardiac rehabilitation, commonly including early activity during or soon after hospitalization, a structured recovery program, and longer-term self-management. Some systems divide rehabilitation into four phases, so the labels and

number of phases vary by program.

Cardiac Rehab Outcomes

Cardiac rehabilitation can improve exercise ability, blood-pressure and cholesterol control, confidence, quality of life, and psychological well-being after selected heart conditions. Benefits vary with the program, health condition, and participation.

Cardiac Resynchronization Therapy

A pacing treatment that coordinates contraction of the heart's lower chambers. It is used in selected people with symptomatic heart failure and delayed electrical activation and can improve symptoms, pumping, and survival when appropriate.

Cardiac Rhabdomyoma

A usually noncancerous tumor of heart muscle, most often found in children and associated with tuberous sclerosis. It may shrink on its own but can obstruct blood flow or disturb rhythm and pumping if large.

Cardiac Sarcoidosis

Sarcoidosis involving the heart, characterized by granulomatous inflammation of the myocardium that may lead to fibrosis. It can cause atrioventricular conduction block, ventricular arrhythmias, or ventricular dysfunction and heart failure; severe cases may result in sudden cardiac death.

Cardiac Sarcoma

A rare cancer arising from supporting or connective tissue of the heart. It may obstruct blood flow, disturb heart rhythm, impair pumping, or release clots that travel to other parts of the body.

Cardiac Septum

The wall separating the right and left chambers of the heart, consisting of atrial and ventricular portions and preventing normal mixing of oxygenated and deoxygenated blood.

Cardiac Skeleton

A strong connective-tissue framework around the heart valves and parts of the wall between the chambers. It supports the valves, provides attachment for heart muscle, and helps electrically separate the upper and lower chambers.

Cardiac SPECT

A nuclear scan that shows blood flow to the heart muscle and can help identify reduced flow, prior damage, or living muscle. When synchronized with the heartbeat, it can also assess chamber movement and pumping function.

Cardiac Stress Test

A test that observes the heart while it works harder, usually during exercise or after a medicine increases its workload. It may include an ECG or imaging and can help detect reduced blood flow or abnormal rhythms.

Cardiac Stress Testing

Assessment of the heart during exercise or medicine-induced stress to look for reduced blood flow, abnormal rhythms, or limited pumping reserve. The method is chosen according to the person's ability to exercise and the clinical question.

Cardiac Syncope

Fainting caused by a heart problem that briefly reduces blood flow to the brain. Causes include an abnormal heart rhythm, obstruction to blood flow, or severe heart-muscle weakness. It may occur during exertion or without warning.

Cardiac Syndrome X

Older term, usually referring to microvascular angina; see *Coronary Microvascular Angina*.

Cardiac Tamponade

A life-threatening medical emergency in which fluid, blood, or pus builds up in the pericardium (the sac surrounding the heart). The accumulated fluid puts severe pressure on the heart, preventing its chambers from fully expanding and filling with blood between beats. This dramatically reduces the amount of blood pumped to the body, causing a dangerous drop in blood pressure, muffled heart sounds, and shock.

Cardiac Tamponade Physiology

Pressure from blood or fluid around the heart prevents the chambers from relaxing and filling. This lowers cardiac output and may cause low blood pressure, a marked breathing-related change in pulse pressure, and shock.

Cardiac Transplantation

Replacement of a failing heart with a donor heart in carefully selected people with end-stage heart failure. Lifelong immune-suppressing treatment and regular monitoring are needed for rejection, infection, coronary-vessel disease, and other complications.

Cardiac Tumors

Tumors involving the heart may begin there or spread from another organ. They are rare and may obstruct blood flow, disturb rhythm, cause fluid around the heart, or release clots; treatment depends on type, location, size, and spread.

Cardiac Ventriculography

Imaging of the heart's lower chambers to assess their size, wall movement, and ability to pump blood. It may use x-rays with contrast or another imaging method and is now often replaced by echocardiography or MRI.

Cardiac Volume

The amount of blood in a heart chamber at a particular time. The amount before contraction and after contraction helps assess chamber size, filling, and pumping function.

Cardiac Wall

The three-layered wall of the heart: the inner endocardium, muscular myocardium, and outer epicardium. It supports the heart's structure, electrical activity, contraction, and interaction with surrounding tissues.

Cardialgia

An uncommon, nonspecific term for pain in the precordial region, the front of the chest over the heart. It describes the location of pain, not its cause, and is not synonymous with angina.

Cardinal Body Part

A major body region or structure used in anatomical description or clinical examination, such as the head, neck, chest, abdomen, pelvis, limbs, or an important internal organ.

Cardinal Cell Part

A main component of a cell, such as its membrane, cytoplasm, nucleus, or an organelle. Each part has a role in maintaining the cell, processing information, or performing specialized functions.

Cardinal Ligament

A band of strong connective tissue extending from the cervix and upper vagina to the sidewall of the pelvis. It helps support the uterus and vagina and contains the uterine blood vessels, which cross over the ureter.

Alternate Names:
Mackenrodt's Ligament; Lateral Cervical Ligament; Transverse Cervical Ligament

Cardinal Signs of Inflammation

The four classic signs of inflammation are heat (calor), pain (dolor), redness (rubor), and swelling (tumor). Inflamed tissue may also lose some normal function.

Cardiobacteriaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Cardiobacterium. Some members can enter the bloodstream and infect heart valves, causing infective endocarditis.

Cardiobacterium

A slow-growing bacterium in the HACEK group that can enter the bloodstream and infect heart valves. It may cause prolonged fever, fatigue, weight loss, a new murmur, or embolic complications.

Cardiobacterium Hominis

The Cardiobacterium species most often associated with human infection. It can cause slowly developing infective endocarditis with fever, fatigue, weight loss, a new heart murmur, valve damage, or clots traveling to other organs.

Cardiofaciocutaneous Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder affecting the heart, facial appearance, skin, hair, growth, and development. It is usually caused by a change in a gene involved in cell-growth signals.

Alternate Names:
CFC Syndrome

Cardiogenic Shock

A severe, life-threatening condition that occurs when the heart suddenly cannot pump enough blood and oxygen to meet the body's vital needs, despite having enough fluid in the circulation. It most often develops as a complication of a major heart attack that severely damages the heart muscle. Symptoms include dangerously low blood pressure, cold and clammy skin, rapid breathing, confusion, and reduced urine output.

Cardiolipin

A fat-like molecule found mainly in the inner membrane of mitochondria, the cell's energy-producing structures. Antibodies against cardiolipin can be associated with antiphospholipid syndrome and abnormal blood clotting.

Cardiologist

A doctor trained to diagnose and treat diseases of the heart and blood vessels, including coronary disease, rhythm disorders, valve disease, heart failure, and high blood pressure.

Cardiology

The medical specialty concerned with the structure and function of the heart and cardiovascular system. Cardiologists prevent, diagnose, and treat coronary and structural heart disease, heart failure, arrhythmias, congenital heart disease, and vascular disorders. The field also includes cardiovascular risk assessment and prevention.

Cardiomegaly

Enlargement of the heart seen on examination or imaging. It may result from enlarged chambers, thickened heart muscle, fluid around the heart, or a combination; causes include high blood pressure, valve disease, cardiomyopathy, and congenital disease.

Cardiometabolic

Relating to the interaction between heart and blood-vessel disease and metabolic conditions such as obesity, insulin resistance, diabetes, and abnormal blood lipids.

Cardiomyopathy

A disease of the heart muscle that can make it enlarged, thickened, stiff, or weak. These changes can make it harder for the heart to pump or fill with blood and may cause heart failure or abnormal heart rhythms. Major types include dilated, hypertrophic, and restrictive cardiomyopathy.

Cardiomyopathy Classification

A system for describing cardiomyopathy by its heart structure and function, other organs involved, genetic pattern, cause, and functional severity. This information helps communicate diagnosis, guide testing, and estimate prognosis.

Cardio-Oncology

The medical field focused on preventing and treating heart and blood-vessel problems in people with cancer. It monitors effects of chemotherapy, targeted or immune treatment, and chest radiation while helping cancer therapy continue safely when possible.

Cardiopathy

Any disease or disorder of the heart, including problems of the heart muscle, valves, coronary arteries, electrical rhythm, or structure present from birth.

Cardioplegia

Temporary stopping and protection of the heart during open-heart surgery, usually by delivering a cold solution that changes electrical and metabolic activity. It allows the surgeon to operate while limiting heart-muscle injury.

Cardiopulmonary

Relating to the heart and lungs or to their combined function. For example, cardiopulmonary exercise testing assesses how the heart, lungs, blood, and muscles respond during physical activity.

Alternate Names:
Cardiorespiratory

Cardiopulmonary Bypass

A heart-lung machine temporarily takes over circulation and oxygen exchange during some operations. It pumps and oxygenates blood while the heart is stopped or opened; possible complications include bleeding, inflammation, clots, stroke, and organ injury.

Cardiopulmonary Bypass Machine

A machine that temporarily pumps and oxygenates blood during selected heart or major-vessel operations. It allows surgeons to work while the heart is stopped or the lungs are not carrying out their usual gas exchange.

Alternate Names:
Heart-Lung Machine; Cardiopulmonary Bypass Pump

Cardiopulmonary Exercise Testing

A monitored treadmill or bicycle test that measures how the heart, lungs, blood, and muscles respond as exercise becomes harder. It helps assess unexplained breathlessness, exercise limitation, and severity of heart or lung disease.

Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

Emergency care for a person whose heart has stopped pumping blood effectively. It uses chest compressions and, when appropriate, rescue breaths to keep blood and oxygen moving until the heart can be restarted or professional care takes over. An automated external defibrillator may also be used to treat certain heart rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Closed-Chest Cardiac Massage

Cardiorenal Syndrome

A condition in which heart and kidney dysfunction worsen one another. Sudden or long-term heart disease can injure the kidneys, and sudden or long-term kidney disease can strain the heart; treatment must address both organs.

Cardiorespiratory

Relating to the heart, blood vessels, and respiratory system considered together, as in cardiorespiratory fitness, monitoring, or failure.

Cardiorespiratory Endurance

The ability of the heart, lungs, blood, and muscles to deliver and use oxygen during sustained physical activity. It is influenced by fitness, heart and lung disease, anemia, muscle condition, and other factors.

Alternate Names:
Cardiorespiratory Fitness; Aerobic Endurance

Cardioscope

A historical term for an instrument used to view the interior of the heart directly. The associated procedure, cardioscopy, did not become established and has been superseded by modern cardiac imaging.

Cardioselective Beta-Blockers

Beta-blocker medicines that mainly block beta-1 receptors in the heart, slowing the heart rate and reducing its workload. They may still narrow airways at higher doses and are used for selected heart, blood-pressure, and rhythm conditions.

Cardiospasm

Older term; see *Achalasia*.

Cardiotocography

Electronic recording of the fetal heart rate and uterine contractions, most often during labor. Monitoring may be continuous or intermittent; the heart-rate pattern is interpreted in relation to contractions, gestational age, and the clinical situation.

Cardiotomy

A surgical incision into a heart chamber to gain

access to its interior during an operation.

Cardiotoxicity

Injury or impaired function of the heart caused by a medicine, toxin, radiation, or disease. It may produce rhythm problems, reduced heart-muscle strength, chest pain from poor blood flow, or heart failure.

Cardiotoxicity From Chemotherapy

Heart injury caused by some chemotherapy medicines. It may weaken heart muscle, reduce pumping, or cause rhythm problems during or after treatment; risk depends on the medicine, dose, other treatments, and existing heart disease.

Cardiotoxin

A substance that directly injures heart muscle or disrupts the heart's electrical activity or blood supply. It may cause abnormal rhythms, reduced pumping, heart failure, or heart-muscle injury.

Cardiovascular

Relating to the heart and blood vessels, including circulation, blood pressure, and diseases affecting the heart or vascular system.

Cardiovascular Agents

Medicines that act on the heart or blood vessels. They include treatments for high blood pressure, abnormal rhythms, angina, heart failure, blood clots, and abnormal cholesterol levels.

Cardiovascular Changes In Pregnancy

During pregnancy, blood volume and cardiac output increase to support the uterus and developing baby. The rise in plasma is greater than the rise in red cells, causing normal dilutional anemia; heart rate and blood-vessel resistance also change.

Cardiovascular Disease

Disease of the heart or blood vessels, including coronary artery disease, heart failure, abnormal rhythms, valve disease, stroke-related vascular disease, and disorders of arteries or veins.

Cardiovascular Disease and Pregnancy

Heart disease may worsen during pregnancy because blood volume and cardiac output increase, while pregnancy can reveal previously unrecognized disease. Risk depends on the specific lesion and ventricular function; coordinated cardiology and maternal-fetal care guides monitoring, medicines, and delivery.

Cardiovascular Health

The condition of the heart and blood vessels and the habits that protect them. Regular activity, not using tobacco, healthy eating, adequate sleep, and control of blood pressure, cholesterol, diabetes, and weight can lower cardiovascular risk.

Cardiovascular Infection

An infection involving the bloodstream, heart, heart valves, or blood vessels. Examples include infective endocarditis, myocarditis, infected vascular grafts, and infected pacemakers or other devices.

Cardiovascular Injury

Damage to the heart or blood vessels caused by trauma, reduced blood flow, inflammation, toxins, surgery, or another disease. Effects may include bleeding, impaired circulation, heart-muscle injury, or abnormal rhythms.

Cardiovascular-Kidney-Metabolic (CKM) Syndrome

A condition involving the interconnected effects of metabolic risk factors, chronic kidney disease, and cardiovascular disease. Its stages range from no identified risk factors (stage 0) to established cardiovascular disease (stage 4).

Cardiovascular Neoplasm

A noncancerous or cancerous tumor arising in the heart, blood vessels, or related tissues. Its symptoms and treatment depend on the tissue type, location, size, effect on circulation, and whether it has spread.

Cardiovascular Pharmacology

The study of how medicines affect the heart, blood vessels, blood pressure, rhythm, blood clotting, and

cholesterol or lipid metabolism, including their uses, interactions, benefits, and risks.

Cardiovascular Prevention in Diabetes

Medical and lifestyle strategies to reduce the high risk of heart attacks and strokes in diabetic patients, including blood pressure control, statin therapy, glucose management, smoking cessation, and healthy diet.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Cardiovascular Risk Reduction; Heart Disease Prevention in Diabetes

Cardiovascular Risk Reduction

Actions that lower the chance of heart attack, stroke, heart failure, and vascular death. They include avoiding tobacco, controlling blood pressure, cholesterol, and diabetes, staying active, eating well, maintaining a healthy weight, and taking indicated medicines.

Cardiovascular Screening

Assessment for cardiovascular risk or disease, often before symptoms develop. It may include blood-pressure measurement, cholesterol and diabetes testing, review of family history and tobacco use, and targeted tests based on age and risk.

Cardiovascular Surgery

Operations on the heart or major blood vessels, including bypass surgery, valve repair or replacement, aortic surgery, and heart transplantation. Many open procedures require a heart-lung machine and specialized care before and after surgery.

Cardiovascular System

The heart, blood, and network of arteries, arterioles, capillaries, venules, and veins that circulate blood through the pulmonary and systemic circuits. It delivers oxygen, nutrients, hormones, and immune cells, carries carbon dioxide and other waste for removal, and helps regulate temperature and blood pressure.

Cardioversion

Restoration of a more regular heart rhythm using a synchronized electrical shock or medicine. Before cardioversion for some atrial rhythms, clinicians assess clot risk and may give anticoagulant treatment to reduce the risk of stroke.

Cardiovirus

A group of viruses in the picornavirus family. Some infect people or animals and may cause fever, muscle inflammation, heart inflammation, or other illness; effects depend on the species and the person's defenses.

Carditis

Inflammation of the heart muscle, inner lining, valves, or surrounding sac. It may result from infection, an immune reaction, medicines, or another inflammatory disease and can cause chest pain, breathlessness, rhythm problems, or heart failure.

Care Coordination

Organizing communication and health-care activities among clinicians, services, patients, and caregivers so care remains safe, continuous, and appropriate when people move between settings or receive several types of treatment.

Caregiver

A family member, friend, or paid worker who helps another person with health care, personal activities, daily tasks, transportation, medicines, or emotional support.

Caregiver Burden

The emotional, physical, social, or financial strain of providing ongoing care for another person. It may lead to exhaustion, low mood, sleep problems, isolation, or difficulty meeting one's own health needs.

Caregiver Stress

Strain caused by caring for another person, often leading to tiredness, worry, irritability, sleep problems, or reduced well-being. Support, respite, counseling, and practical help can reduce its effects.

Caries

A biofilm-mediated, multifactorial disease in which acids from bacterial metabolism of fermentable carbohydrates cause net demineralization of enamel, dentin, or cementum. Early lesions may be arrested or remineralized, but progressive disease forms cavities and can reach the pulp, causing pain or infection.

Caries Risk Assessment

Evaluation of a person's chance of developing tooth decay by reviewing past and current cavities, plaque, diet, fluoride exposure, saliva, oral hygiene, tooth structure, medicines, and medical conditions. Results guide prevention and follow-up.

Carina

The ridge at the bottom of the windpipe where it divides into the right and left main bronchi. It is a landmark during bronchoscopy and breathing-tube placement; inhaled objects more often enter the wider, more vertical right bronchus.

Cariogenic

Likely to promote tooth decay, especially by supplying sugars that plaque bacteria convert into acids or by supporting conditions that remove minerals from teeth.

Cariogram

A computer-based tool that combines factors such as diet, plaque bacteria, fluoride exposure, saliva, previous cavities, and social or clinical history to estimate tooth-decay risk and show where prevention may help.

Carisoprodol

A prescription muscle relaxant used short term for acute painful muscle conditions. It can cause drowsiness, dizziness, impaired coordination, misuse, dependence, and dangerous breathing suppression, especially with alcohol or sedatives.

C-Arm Fluoroscopy

A movable X-ray system that gives live images during a medical procedure. It helps show bones, instruments, blood vessels, or other body parts while the procedure is being performed.

Carminative

A substance used to relieve flatulence by helping gas pass from the digestive tract. The term describes an intended or traditional effect, not one specific medicine.

Alternate Names:
Antiflatulent; Gas-Relieving Agent

Carmine

A red coloring made from cochineal insects and used in some foods, cosmetics, and medicines. Rarely, it causes allergy, wheezing, hives, or anaphylaxis in sensitive people.

Carmustine

A chemotherapy medicine that damages DNA and is used for selected brain tumors, blood cancers, and other cancers. It can lower blood counts and cause nausea, infertility, liver problems, or delayed lung injury.

Carnett Sign

A clinical diagnostic test used to distinguish somatic abdominal wall pain from visceral intra-abdominal pain. The examiner palpates the point of maximal tenderness while the patient tenses the abdominal wall musculature by raising their head and shoulders or lifting both straight legs. Increased or unchanged pain indicates abdominal wall origin (positive Carnett sign), whereas diminished pain suggests an intra-abdominal visceral source.

Alternate Names:
Carnett's Sign; Abdominal Wall Tenderness Test

Carney Complex

A rare inherited disorder, usually caused by a PRKAR1A gene change, that can produce multiple noncancerous skin, heart, and endocrine tumors. It may also cause excess hormones and requires lifelong, organ-specific monitoring.

Carney Triad

A rare condition involving combinations of a stomach gastrointestinal stromal tumor, a benign cartilage tumor in the lung, and a paraganglioma outside the adrenal gland. It usually occurs sporadically and more often affects young women.

Carnitine

A substance that transports long-chain fats into mitochondria, the cell structures that make energy, so the fats can be used as fuel. The body usually makes enough; severe deficiency can cause weakness, low blood sugar, or heart and muscle disease.

Carnitine Deficiency

An abnormally low amount of carnitine, which transports long-chain fatty acids into mitochondria for energy production. Primary inherited or secondary deficiency can cause muscle weakness, low blood sugar, cardiomyopathy, or episodes of metabolic decompensation.

Carnitine Palmitoyltransferase II Deficiency

A rare inherited disorder in which muscle cells cannot use long-chain fats normally for energy. Exercise, fasting, cold, or infection can trigger muscle pain, stiffness, muscle breakdown, dark urine, and kidney injury; symptoms may be absent between attacks.

Alternate Names:
CPT II Deficiency; CPT2 Deficiency

Carnosine

A small molecule made from beta-alanine and histidine, found mainly in muscle and nervous tissue. It helps buffer acidity; claims that supplements prevent disease or improve performance remain uncertain.

Carnosinemia

A rare inherited disorder in which deficient carnosinase causes excess carnosine in blood and urine. Children may have developmental delay, low muscle tone, seizures, or other neurologic problems of varying severity.

Caroli Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which the larger bile ducts inside the liver are widened in segments. It can cause repeated bile-duct infections, stones, abdominal pain, jaundice, and, in some people, liver scarring or kidney disease.

Carotene

An orange-yellow plant pigment found in foods such as carrots and leafy vegetables. Some forms, especially beta-carotene, can be converted to vitamin A; excess intake may harmlessly turn the skin yellow-orange.

Carotenemia

Yellow-orange color of the skin caused by too much carotene, a pigment in foods such as carrots and sweet potatoes. It often shows on the palms and soles; the whites of the eyes stay white, unlike in jaundice.

Alternate Names:
Carotenoid Pigments

Carotenoid

A class of fat-soluble tetraterpenoid pigments synthesized by plants, algae, and photosynthetic microorganisms, responsible for yellow, orange, and red pigmentation. Provitamin A carotenoids (such as β-carotene, α-carotene, and β-cryptoxanthin) are cleaved in the intestinal mucosa by β-carotene oxygenase to form retinal (vitamin A). Non-provitamin A carotenoids (including lutein, zeaxanthin, and lycopene) exert potent antioxidant effects; lutein and zeaxanthin selectively concentrate in the retinal macula lutea to filter harmful blue light and mitigate phototoxic damage.

Carotenoids

Plural form; see *Carotenoid*.

Carotid

Relating to the paired arteries in the neck whose internal branches supply the brain and whose external branches supply much of the head and neck.

Carotid Artery

One of the major arteries supplying the head and neck. Each common carotid divides into an internal branch that supplies the brain and an external branch that supplies much of the face, scalp, and neck.

Carotid Artery Disease

Narrowing or blockage of a carotid artery, usually from fatty plaque. It can reduce blood flow to the brain or release a clot and cause a transient ischemic attack or ischemic stroke.

Carotid Artery Dissection

A tear in the inner lining of a main artery in the neck. Blood can enter the wall and weaken or narrow the artery, sometimes causing head or neck pain, a drooping eyelid, stroke-like symptoms, or a stroke.

Carotid Artery Stenosis

Narrowing of an artery in the neck that supplies the brain, usually from fatty plaque. It may reduce blood flow or release a clot and increase the risk of a transient ischemic attack or stroke.

Carotid Artery Stenting

A procedure that places a small mesh tube inside a narrowed carotid artery to keep it open. It is used selectively to reduce stroke risk; clot release, stroke, bleeding, and re-narrowing are possible complications.

Carotid Body

A small group of sensing cells near the division of the common carotid artery. It detects changes in blood oxygen, carbon dioxide, and acidity and sends signals that help adjust breathing.

Carotid Body Tumor

A usually slow-growing growth beside the point where the main neck artery divides. It often causes a painless lump, but may press on nearby nerves or blood vessels. A small number spread to other parts of the body.

Alternate Names:
Carotid Body Tumour; Chemodectoma; Carotid Paraganglioma; Glomus Caroticum Tumor

Carotid Bruit

A blowing sound heard over a carotid artery when blood flow is turbulent. It can occur with plaque but does not reliably show how narrow the artery is; ultrasound or other vascular imaging is needed when disease is suspected.

Carotid Cavernous Fistula

An abnormal connection between blood vessels near the carotid artery and a large vein behind the eye. It may cause a bulging or red eye, a pulsing noise, double vision, high eye pressure, or reduced vision. Brain and blood-vessel imaging is used for diagnosis. Treatment depends on the type and may include endovascular closure.

Alternate Names:
Caroticocavernous Sinus Fistula; CCF; Carotid-Cavernous Sinus Fistula

Carotid Doppler Ultrasound

A noninvasive vascular ultrasound using sound waves and Doppler effect to evaluate blood flow and detect narrowing or atherosclerotic plaques in the carotid arteries; see *Carotid Duplex Ultrasound*.

Carotid Duplex Ultrasound

An ultrasound test that shows plaque and measures blood flow through the carotid arteries. It helps estimate narrowing without radiation and may guide decisions about medicines, surgery, or stenting.

Carotid Endarterectomy

Surgery to open a carotid artery and remove fatty plaque from its inner wall. It can reduce stroke risk in selected people with significant narrowing, especially after symptoms, but carries risks such as stroke, heart attack, and nerve injury.

Carotid Glomus

A specialized peripheral chemoreceptor sensory organ located in the adventitia of the carotid bifurcation, containing glomus type I cells that detect arterial hypoxemia, hypercapnia, and acidosis to

reflexively stimulate respiration via the glossopharyngeal nerve.

Alternate Names:
Carotid Body

Carotid Occlusion

Complete blockage of an artery supplying the brain, usually from plaque or a blood clot. Some people have no symptoms because other vessels compensate, but sudden weakness, speech trouble, or vision loss is an emergency.

Carotid Sinus Hypersensitivity

An exaggerated reflex response to tactile mechanical stimulation of the carotid sinus baroreceptors, producing marked bradycardia (cardioinhibitory type), profound hypotension (vasodepressor type), or both, predisposing to presyncope or syncope.

Carotid Sinus Massage

A clinical maneuver that stimulates pressure-sensitive receptors near the carotid artery to assess carotid sinus reflexes or help terminate selected supraventricular tachycardias. It can cause marked slowing of the heart, a fall in blood pressure, or fainting, so it is performed with electrocardiographic and blood-pressure monitoring after assessment of vascular risks.

Alternate Names:
Carotid Sinus Stimulation; Carotid Baroreceptor Massage

Carotid Stenosis

Narrowing of a carotid artery, usually from fatty plaque. It may reduce blood flow to the brain or release a clot, causing a transient ischemic attack or stroke; treatment depends on symptoms, severity, and overall risk.

Carpal Bones

The eight small bones forming the wrist: scaphoid, lunate, triquetrum, pisiform, trapezium, trapezoid, capitate, and hamate. They connect the forearm to the hand and work together to allow wrist movement and transmit force.

Alternate Names:
Carpals

Carpal Joints

The joints between the wrist bones and between the wrist, forearm, and hand bones. Together they allow the wrist to bend, straighten, move side to side, and rotate with the forearm.

Carpal Tunnel

A narrow passage on the palm side of the wrist formed by the wrist bones and a strong ligament. It contains the median nerve and finger-flexing tendons; pressure on the nerve causes carpal tunnel syndrome.

Carpal Tunnel Biopsy

Removal of a small tissue sample from the carpal tunnel or its contents when an unusual infiltrative, inflammatory, infectious, or tumor-related process is suspected. It is not a routine test for ordinary carpal tunnel syndrome.

Carpal Tunnel Release

Surgery that cuts the ligament forming the roof of the wrist tunnel to relieve pressure on the median nerve. It may improve numbness, tingling, pain, and weakness when symptoms do not respond to suitable nonsurgical care.

Carpal Tunnel Syndrome

Compression of the median nerve as it passes through the carpal tunnel at the wrist. It commonly causes numbness, tingling, burning, or pain in the thumb, index and middle fingers, and thumb-side part of the ring finger. Symptoms often worsen at night, and weakness at the base of the thumb may develop.

Alternate Names:
CTS; Median Nerve Entrapment

Carpal Tunnel Syndrome Tests

Examination and nerve tests used to assess suspected median-nerve compression. Wrist-position or tapping tests may reproduce symptoms, while nerve-conduction studies and ultrasound can support diagnosis and assess severity when needed.

Carpometacarpal Joint

A joint between a wrist bone and the base of a hand bone. The thumb joint is a mobile saddle-shaped joint that allows opposition and is commonly affected by osteoarthritis.

Carpus

The group of eight small bones forming the wrist between the forearm and the metacarpals of the hand. The carpus provides stability while allowing controlled wrist movement.

Carrageenan

A substance extracted from red seaweed and used to thicken or stabilize some foods and medicines. Different forms have different properties; evidence about effects on human inflammation depends on the type and amount consumed.

Carrier

In genetics, a person who has one altered copy of a gene for a recessive condition and usually has no symptoms. A carrier can pass the altered gene to a child; the chance that the child is affected depends on the other biological parent's genes and the condition's inheritance pattern.

Carrier Excipient

An inactive ingredient that supports an active medicine in a formulation. It may help control the medicine's dose, stability, absorption, appearance, or delivery and can occasionally cause allergy or intolerance.

Carrier-Mediated Transport

Movement of a substance across a cell membrane with help from a specific carrier protein. It may use no direct energy when moving down a concentration gradient or use energy to move against that gradient.

Carrier Screening

Genetic testing for people without symptoms to find whether they carry a harmful gene variant that could be passed to a child. Results can guide reproductive choices and may identify the need to test a partner or relatives.

Carrier State

A state in which a person harbors an infectious microorganism without symptoms and may shed it. The ability to transmit the infection and how long the carrier state lasts depend on the microorganism and stage of infection.

Carry-Over Effect

Persistence of an earlier treatment's effect into a later measurement or treatment period. It can distort results in crossover studies or make a person's current clinical state difficult to interpret.

CAR T-Cell

A T lymphocyte genetically changed to carry a receptor that recognizes a specific marker on cancer cells. These cells can be used as treatment for selected blood cancers but may cause severe immune reactions or nervous-system effects.

CAR T-Cell Therapy

An immunotherapy in which a person's T cells are changed in a laboratory to carry a chimeric antigen receptor (CAR) that recognizes a specific marker on cancer cells. The cells are grown and infused back into the body. This treatment is used for selected blood cancers and may cause serious immune or nervous-system effects.

Carteolol

A nonselective beta-blocker used mainly as eye drops to lower pressure inside the eye in open-angle glaucoma or ocular hypertension. It can sometimes slow the heartbeat, lower blood pressure, or worsen breathing problems.

Cartilage

A tough, flexible tissue found in joints, the ear, nose, rib cage, and spinal discs. It cushions joints, supports body structures, and resists pressure, but it has limited blood supply and heals slowly after injury.

Cartilage Disease

A disorder that damages cartilage in joints or supporting structures. It can cause pain, stiffness,

swelling, deformity, impaired growth, or loss of smooth movement and may result from injury, aging, inflammation, or inherited disease.

Cartilaginous Joint

A joint in which bones are connected by cartilage and allow little or limited movement. Examples include joints between spinal bones and the joint joining the two front pelvic bones.

Caruncles

Small fleshy anatomical projections. Examples include the lacrimal caruncle at the inner corner of the eye and the urethral caruncle near the opening of the urethra.

Carvallo Sign

A physical examination finding in which the pansystolic murmur of tricuspid regurgitation increases in intensity during inspiration. The accentuation is caused by increased venous return to the right heart during the inspiratory phase of respiration.

Alternate Names:
Carvallo's Sign; Rivero-Carvallo Sign

Carvedilol

A beta-blocker that also relaxes blood vessels. It slows the heart and reduces its workload and is used for selected cases of high blood pressure, heart failure, and after a heart attack; it can lower blood pressure and heart rate.

CAS

Alternate name; see *Childhood Apraxia Of Speech*.

Casanthranol

A stimulant laxative that increases bowel movement and secretion of water into the intestine. Prolonged or excessive use can cause diarrhea, dehydration, electrolyte abnormalities, and reliance on laxatives.

Cascade

A series of linked reactions in which one activated step triggers the next. Examples include the blood-clotting, complement, and inflammatory cascades.

Cascara

A plant-derived stimulant laxative that increases bowel movement. Prolonged or excessive use can cause diarrhea, dehydration, electrolyte imbalance, and reliance on laxatives; its use is restricted in some places.

Case Definition

Standardized clinical, laboratory, and exposure criteria used to classify a person as a suspected, probable, or confirmed case during surveillance or an outbreak investigation. It may differ from the criteria used to diagnose one patient.

Case Fatality Rate

The proportion of people diagnosed with a disease who die from it during a stated period. It describes severity in a particular group, but depends on accurate diagnosis, follow-up, treatment, and the population studied.

Case-Fatality Rate

Alternate spelling; see *Case Fatality Rate*.

Casein

The main family of proteins in cow's milk and other mammalian milk. It supplies amino acids and minerals and forms curds during digestion and cheese-making; it can trigger reactions in people with cow's-milk protein allergy.

Casein Kinase

A family of enzymes that attach phosphate groups to proteins and thereby change their activity. Casein kinases help regulate cell signaling, growth, DNA repair, development, and the body's internal clock.

Case Management

Coordinated planning, referral, and follow-up of health and social services to help a person receive appropriate care, avoid gaps or duplication, and meet clinical, functional, and personal goals.

Caseous

Cheese-like, especially describing the soft, crumbly,

dull, opaque appearance of caseous necrosis, a pattern of tissue death classically seen in tuberculosis and some other infections. The word derives from Latin *caseus*, meaning “cheese”; casein, a major milk protein that forms curds, has the same root.

Caseous Necrosis

A form of tissue death producing soft, crumbly, white or yellow material that resembles cheese. It is classically seen in granulomas caused by tuberculosis, though similar changes can occur in some other chronic infections.

Cashew Allergy

An immune reaction to cashew proteins that may cause itching, hives, swelling, vomiting, wheezing, or life-threatening anaphylaxis. People with this allergy should avoid cashews and follow an emergency action plan.

Caspase

A group of enzymes that cut specific proteins inside cells. Some initiate orderly programmed cell death, while others activate inflammation and immune defense against infection.

Caspase Activation

Conversion of inactive caspase enzymes into their active form inside a cell. Depending on the caspase and triggering signal, this can start programmed cell death or activate inflammation and immune defense.

Caspofungin

An intravenous antifungal medicine that blocks construction of an important fungal cell-wall component. It is used for serious Candida infections and selected Aspergillus infections and may cause liver-test abnormalities, infusion reactions, or low potassium.

Caspofungin Acetate

The acetate salt form of caspofungin, an intravenous antifungal medicine that blocks fungal cell-wall construction. It is used for selected serious Candida and Aspergillus infections under medical supervision.

Cassette

A holder that contains recording or imaging material. In traditional radiography, it held the film or image receptor during exposure; the word may also describe holders used in laboratory or monitoring equipment.

Cast

A rigid or semi-rigid support placed around an injured limb or joint to limit movement while a bone, ligament, tendon, or other tissue heals. It must be monitored for swelling, pressure injury, numbness, or poor circulation.

Castleman Disease

A group of uncommon disorders causing abnormal enlargement and activity of lymph nodes. Disease may affect one lymph-node area or the whole body and can cause fever, fatigue, anemia, weight loss, and organ problems.

Cast Nephropathy

A classic renal manifestation of multiple myeloma in which excessive circulating monoclonal immunoglobulin free light chains (Bence-Jones proteins) precipitate with Tamm-Horsfall mucoprotein in distal tubules, forming dense casts that obstruct tubules and induce giant cell inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Myeloma Kidney

Castor Oil

A vegetable oil from the seeds of Ricinus communis. Taken by mouth, it acts as a stimulant laxative; excessive use can cause cramping, diarrhea, dehydration, and electrolyte disturbances.

Castor Oil Overdose

Excessive ingestion of castor oil, causing intestinal irritation, cramping, nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea. Severe exposure can cause dehydration, low blood pressure, or fluid and electrolyte imbalance.

Castration

Removal or functional suppression of the testes or

ovaries, reducing production of sex hormones. It may be surgical or achieved with medicines and can affect fertility, sexual function, mood, and bone health.

Catabolism

The set of chemical processes that break down complex molecules such as carbohydrates, fats, and proteins into simpler substances, releasing energy that cells can use. Examples include digestion-related breakdown, glycolysis, and fat oxidation.

Catagen

The short transition phase of the hair cycle between active growth and rest. The hair follicle shrinks, hair growth stops, and the hair remains attached until the later shedding phase.

Alternate Names:
Catagen Phase; Regression Phase of Hair Growth

Catalase

An enzyme that breaks down hydrogen peroxide into water and oxygen. It protects cells from oxidative damage and helps some bacteria survive inside immune cells.

Catalepsy

A state of greatly reduced movement and responsiveness in which a person may remain rigid or hold an imposed posture. It can occur with catatonia, narcolepsy, neurologic disease, or some psychiatric conditions.

Cat Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins in cat saliva, skin flakes, or other secretions. It can cause sneezing, itchy eyes, wheezing, hives, or asthma symptoms; severity varies with exposure and individual sensitivity.

Catalyst

A substance that speeds a chemical reaction without being used up. It works by providing an easier reaction pathway; enzymes are biological catalysts, and catalysts change reaction speed without changing the final balance of products and reactants.

Catamenial Epilepsy

A pattern in which seizures become more frequent or severe at certain times in the menstrual cycle. Hormone changes may contribute, and a seizure diary can help guide neurologic treatment.

Catamenial Pneumothorax

Repeated collapse of a lung occurring around the start of menstruation, usually because of thoracic endometriosis. It often affects the right side and causes sudden chest pain or breathlessness; recurrent cases need specialist evaluation and may require surgery or hormone treatment.

Alternate Names:
Endometriosis-Related Pneumothorax; Catamenial Thorax

Cataplexy

A sudden, brief loss of muscle strength triggered by strong emotion such as laughter, surprise, or anger. Awareness usually remains clear; it is strongly associated with narcolepsy and may cause the head, jaw, knees, or whole body to buckle.

Cataract

Clouding of the eye's natural lens, which reduces the passage of light to the retina. It can cause blurred or faded vision, glare, poor contrast, and difficulty seeing at night.

Cataract Removal

Surgery that removes a cloudy natural lens from the eye and usually replaces it with an artificial intraocular lens. It is performed when the cataract interferes with vision, work, driving, reading, or other daily activities.

Cataracts

Alternate index label; see *Cataract*.

Alternate Names:
Adult Cataracts; Cataracts in Adults

Cataract Surgery

Surgery to remove the eye's clouded natural lens, usually replacing it with an artificial intraocular

lens to focus light. Phacoemulsification is a common technique for removing the lens.

Catastrophic Aging

A rapid loss of physical or mental function in an older person after illness, an operation, a fall, or another stress. Limited ability to recover can make decline harder to reverse; early treatment and rehabilitation may help.

Catastrophic Reaction

An unusually intense emotional or behavioral response to a situation that may seem minor to others. It can occur with dementia, brain injury, or other neurologic disease and may involve shouting, fear, crying, or agitation.

Alternate Names:
Catastrophic Response; Catastrophic Emotional Reaction

Catatonia

A serious syndrome involving marked changes in movement, speech, and response to the environment. Features may include immobility, mutism, staring, unusual postures, rigidity, repetitive movements, or copying speech or actions; causes include psychiatric and medical disorders.

Catbite

A puncture wound caused by a cat's teeth. Cat bites can push bacteria deep into tissue and may infect tendons, joints, or bone.

Catch-Up Immunization

Vaccination of a person who is behind the recommended schedule using age- and risk-appropriate intervals. A delayed series usually does not need to be restarted, but minimum ages, intervals, and medical precautions must be followed.

Catechin

A group of plant compounds found in tea, cocoa, some fruits, and other foods. They show antioxidant effects in laboratory studies, but catechin supplements are not proven treatments and may cause side effects or interact with medicines.

Catechol

A chemical compound with two neighboring hydroxyl groups, used in industry and involved in making some biologically active substances. Contact or inhalation can irritate tissues and substantial exposure may be toxic.

Catecholamine

A class of chemical messengers derived from tyrosine, including dopamine, norepinephrine (noradrenaline), and epinephrine (adrenaline). Depending on where they are released, they act as neurotransmitters or hormones. Their effects vary by tissue and include roles in sympathetic stress responses, movement, attention, and cardiovascular function.

Alternate Names:
Catecholamines

Catecholamine Blood Test

A blood test measuring epinephrine, norepinephrine, and dopamine. It may help evaluate unusual hormone release from a pheochromocytoma or related tumor, although metanephrine testing is often preferred for initial screening.

Catecholamine Crisis

A sudden, life-threatening surge of stress hormones causing very high blood pressure, rapid or irregular heartbeat, sweating, headache, and possible injury to the heart, brain, kidneys, or other organs. It can occur with certain adrenal or nerve tumors.

Catecholaminergic Polymorphic Ventricular Tachycardia

A rare inherited rhythm disorder in which exercise or strong emotion triggers dangerous fast rhythms from the heart's lower chambers. The heart may look normal and the resting ECG may be normal; fainting or cardiac arrest can occur, especially in children and young adults.

Alternate Names:
Bidirectional Ventricular Tachycardia; Stress-Induced Polymorphic VT

Category Five Hurricane

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of at least 157 miles per hour (252 km/h), capable of catastrophic damage and prolonged loss of habitability.

Category I Fetal Heart Tracing

A reassuring fetal heart-rate pattern with a baseline of 110–160 beats per minute, moderate variability, and no late or variable decelerations. It is usually consistent with adequate fetal oxygenation at that time.

Category II Fetal Heart Tracing

A fetal heart-rate pattern that is not clearly normal or abnormal. It requires continued monitoring and assessment of the mother, fetus, labor, and changes over time because it may become reassuring or concerning.

Category III Fetal Heart Tracing

An abnormal intrapartum fetal heart rate pattern associated with increased risk of fetal acidemia. It consists of absent baseline variability with recurrent late decelerations, recurrent variable decelerations, or bradycardia; a sinusoidal pattern is also Category III. The classification describes the tracing, not a diagnosis of acidemia.

Category Three Hurricane

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of 111–129 miles per hour (178–208 km/h), capable of devastating damage.

Category Two Hurricane

A Saffir–Simpson hurricane with sustained winds of 96–110 miles per hour (154–177 km/h), capable of extensive damage to structures and vegetation.

Catenin

A family of proteins that helps neighboring cells attach and communicate. Beta-catenin also carries growth signals inside cells; abnormal activity can allow some cancers to grow or spread.

Caterpillar Dermatitis

An itchy or painful skin reaction after contact with irritating or venomous caterpillar hairs or spines. Eye exposure, breathing difficulty, or widespread symptoms may occur in more severe reactions.

Caterpillars

The larval stage of butterflies and moths. Hairs or spines on some species can cause painful skin inflammation, eye injury, or allergic reactions after contact or inhalation.

Cathartic

A substance that promotes bowel emptying, usually by increasing stool water, intestinal movement, or both. Excessive or prolonged use can cause diarrhea, dehydration, electrolyte imbalance, or dependence on laxatives.

Alternate Names:
Purgative; Laxative

Cathepsin

A family of enzymes that break down proteins inside cells, especially in lysosomes, the cell's recycling compartments. They help with immune activity, tissue remodeling, and bone turnover; abnormal activity may contribute to inflammation, bone loss, or cancer.

Cathepsin D

An enzyme in lysosomes that breaks down proteins in an acidic environment. It also participates in cell death and immune processes; abnormal activity has been studied in cancer and nervous-system disease.

Cathepsin H

An enzyme in lysosomes that breaks down proteins and helps activate some biologically active peptides. It contributes to normal cell maintenance and may be altered in certain diseases.

Cathepsin K

An enzyme made by osteoclasts, the cells that remove old bone. It breaks down the protein framework of bone; excessive activity can contribute to

bone loss and osteoporosis.

Cathepsin L

An enzyme in lysosomes that breaks down proteins and helps process antigens for immune recognition. It also participates in tissue remodeling and can assist entry or spread of some infectious agents.

Cathepsins B

A group of protein-cutting enzymes, including cathepsin B, that help recycle proteins inside cells. Abnormal activity can contribute to inflammation, tissue remodeling, invasion of nearby tissue by tumors, and spread of cancer.

Cathepsin Z

An enzyme found mainly in lysosomes that cuts proteins into smaller pieces. It helps cells process materials and may contribute to immune responses and inflammation.

Catheter

A thin flexible tube placed in a blood vessel, body cavity, or duct to deliver medicines or fluids, drain urine or other material, measure pressure, collect samples, or guide a procedure.

Catheter-Associated Urinary Tract Infection

A symptomatic urinary tract infection in a person with a urinary catheter or recent catheterization. Bacteriuria is common with catheter use, and pyuria alone does not distinguish infection from asymptomatic colonization. The 48-hour catheter threshold is used in surveillance definitions, not as a stand-alone clinical diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
CAUTI

Catheter-Associated UTI

A urinary infection associated with an indwelling catheter. Risk rises with prolonged use, and symptoms may include fever, lower abdominal or flank pain, or confusion; avoiding unnecessary catheters and removing them early lowers risk.

Catheter-Directed Thrombolysis

A procedure that uses imaging to guide a thin tube into a blood clot. Clot-dissolving medicine is delivered through the tube to help break up the clot. It may be used for selected serious clots; the treatment can cause dangerous bleeding.

Alternate Names:
CDT; Endovascular Thrombolysis; Catheter-Directed Clot Lysis

Catheterization

Placement of a catheter into a blood vessel, body cavity, duct, or other passage to drain, infuse, measure, collect samples, or perform a procedure. Risks include pain, bleeding, infection, blockage, and injury to nearby tissue.

Catheterized Urine Culture

A urine culture performed on a specimen collected through urinary catheterization, usually when a clean-catch sample cannot be obtained or when catheter-associated infection is being assessed. Collection technique and timing affect interpretation because colonization and contamination may cause bacterial growth without symptomatic infection.

Catheter-Related Infections

Infections caused by microorganisms entering along or contaminating an indwelling catheter. They may cause local redness, pain, drainage, fever, or bloodstream infection; treatment can involve antibiotics and catheter removal or replacement.

Catheter-Related UTI

A urinary tract infection associated with an indwelling urinary catheter, usually caused by bacteria entering or traveling along it. Diagnosis requires compatible symptoms and appropriately collected urine testing because bacteria may be present without infection.

Cathexis

The investment of emotional or psychological energy in a person, idea, object, or activity, a term used mainly in psychology and psychoanalytic theory.

Cation

An atom or molecule with a positive electrical charge, such as sodium, potassium, calcium, or hydrogen. These charged particles help control fluid balance, nerve signals, muscle contraction, and blood acidity.

Alternate Names:
Positively Charged Ion

Cat-Nap

A short period of sleep, usually during the day. Frequent unintended sleep may be associated with inadequate sleep, a medicine effect, or a sleep disorder.

CAT Scan

Older name; see *Computed Tomography*.

Cat Scratch Disease

An infection caused by *Bartonella henselae*, usually when a scratch or bite from a kitten or cat introduces bacteria carried in flea dirt. A small bump may form at the injury, followed one to three weeks later by tender swelling of nearby lymph nodes and sometimes a low fever. Most cases resolve on their own; rarely, infection affects the eyes, liver, spleen, brain, bones, or heart valves, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Cat-Scratch Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Cat Scratch Disease*.

Cat's Cry Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Cri-Du-Chat Syndrome*.

Cat's Eye Reflex

A bright white reflection from the pupil, called leukocoria, rather than the usual red reflection in photographs. It can signal cataract, retinal disease, or retinoblastoma, especially in a child.

Caudad

Toward the tail or lower end of the body; in human anatomy, generally toward the feet or away from the head.

Cauda Equina

The bundle of lumbar, sacral, and coccygeal nerve roots that continues below the end of the spinal cord. These nerves control sensation and movement in the legs and help control the bladder, bowel, and sexual organs.

Alternate Names:
Cauda Equina Nerve Roots; Horse-Tail Nerve Bundle

Cauda Equina Syndrome

A serious neurological condition that occurs when the bundle of nerve roots at the lower end of the spinal cord (called the cauda equina, or 'horse's tail') becomes severely compressed, commonly by a herniated disc, spinal injury, tumor, or infection. Because these nerves supply the bladder, bowel, and legs, compression can cause sharp lower back and leg pain, weakness or numbness in both legs, numbness in the groin and buttocks ('saddle anesthesia'), and loss of bladder or bowel control.

Caudal

Directed toward the tail end of the body; in general human anatomy, usually toward the feet or away from the head. In neuroanatomy, direction follows the curved axis of the central nervous system, so caudal in the cerebrum points toward the back of the head.

Caudal Dysplasia

A group of birth defects in which the lower spine and nearby structures do not develop fully. It may cause abnormalities of the legs, pelvis, bowel, bladder, or genital organs and is more common with maternal diabetes.

Caudate Nucleus

A curved group of nerve cells deep in the brain that helps control movement, learning, memory, motivation, and behavior. Disease affecting it may contribute to movement or cognitive problems.

Cauliflower Ear

A thick, irregular deformity of the outer ear caused when blood or fluid collects between its cartilage

and covering, usually after blunt injury or repeated friction. Persistent separation of the cartilage covering from the ear can lead to permanent deformity.

Alternate Names:
Auricular Hematoma Deformity; Boxer's Ear; Wrestler's Ear

Caulking Compound Poisoning

Poisoning or injury after contact with or swallowing a caulking product. Symptoms depend on its ingredients and may include eye, skin, or airway irritation, vomiting, drowsiness, or aspiration into the lungs.

Causalgia

Severe persistent burning pain, sensitivity, and other sensory changes after injury to a peripheral nerve. It is now usually considered complex regional pain syndrome type II and may include swelling, color or temperature changes, and movement difficulty.

Alternate Names:
Complex Regional Pain Syndrome Type II; Causalgic Pain

Cause Of Death

The disease, injury, or toxic exposure that starts the chain of events leading directly to death. It differs from the immediate mechanism, such as respiratory failure, and from contributing conditions.

Causes of Cancer

Cancer develops after changes in cells allow abnormal growth and survival. Risk can be increased by inherited variants, tobacco, alcohol, certain infections, ultraviolet or other radiation, harmful chemicals, chronic inflammation, and random changes during cell division.

Alternate Names:
Carcinogenesis; Cancer Etiology; Oncogenic Factors

Caustic

Able to chemically burn or destroy living tissue, as strong acids and alkalis can. Swallowing or contact with a caustic substance can injure the mouth, esophagus, stomach, skin, eyes, or airway and may be an emergency.

Cauterization

Intentional destruction or sealing of tissue with heat, electricity, chemicals, or another energy source. It may control bleeding, remove abnormal tissue, or close small vessels and wounds.

Cautery

Use of heat, electricity, chemicals, or another energy source to destroy or seal tissue, commonly to control bleeding or remove a small abnormal area.

Cautery Device

A medical instrument that uses heat, electricity, or another energy source to seal bleeding vessels or destroy unwanted tissue. Use can cause burns or damage surrounding structures if poorly controlled.

Caveola

A small pocket-like fold in a cell membrane that helps organize signals, move materials into or out of the cell, and respond to stretching or mechanical stress.

Caveolins

Proteins that form or regulate caveolae, small pockets in cell membranes. They help organize cell signals, handle fats, move materials across membranes, and respond to mechanical stress.

Cavernous Hemangioma

A cluster of enlarged, thin-walled blood vessels that may occur in the skin, brain, spinal cord, or other tissues. Symptoms depend on location and may result from bleeding, pressure, pain, or altered function.

Cavernous Malformations

Clusters of unusually wide, fragile blood vessels, usually in the brain or spinal cord. They may cause no symptoms, but bleeding or pressure on nerve tissue can produce headaches, seizures, weakness, numbness, vision problems, or other neurologic changes.

Alternate Names:
Cavernoma; Cerebral Cavernoma

Cavernous Sinus

A large venous channel beside the pituitary gland that drains blood from the eye and face. It contains important eye-movement nerves and the internal carotid artery; infection or clotting there can be life-threatening.

Cavernous Sinus Thrombosis

A dangerous blood clot, often infected, in the venous channel behind the eyes. It usually follows infection of the face, nose, sinuses, teeth, or orbit and may cause severe headache, fever, bulging eyes, double vision, or vision loss.

Cavities

Holes or damaged areas in teeth caused by acids made by plaque bacteria from sugars and other carbohydrates. Decay can reach the inner pulp and cause pain or infection; dental care may include fluoride, fillings, or root-canal procedures.

Alternate Names:
Tooth Decay; Dental Caries; Dental Cavitation

Cavities And Tooth Decay

Progressive loss of tooth structure caused by acids produced when plaque bacteria use sugars. Decay can move from enamel into dentin and the pulp, causing sensitivity, pain, infection, abscess, or tooth loss.

Cavity

Alternate name; see *Cavities*.

Cavum

An anatomical cavity or hollow space in the body. The word is usually followed by a location or structure name; for example, the cavum septi pellucidi is a normal fluid-filled space in the brain.

CBC

See *Complete Blood Count*.

Alternate Names:
Complete Blood Count

CBC Blood Test

See *Complete Blood Count*.

CCP

Cyclic citrullinated peptide, a target used in a blood test for antibodies associated with rheumatoid arthritis. A positive anti-CCP result supports the diagnosis and may indicate greater risk of joint damage, but it is not diagnostic alone.

CCTA

Alternate name; see *Coronary Computed Tomography Angiography*.

CCU

A hospital unit providing continuous heart monitoring and specialized treatment for people with serious acute cardiac problems, such as heart attack, dangerous rhythm disturbance, or severe heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Coronary Care Unit; Cardiac Care Unit

CD4 Count

The number of CD4 T lymphocytes in a blood sample. It helps assess immune function and the risk of opportunistic infection in people with HIV; results are interpreted with viral load, symptoms, treatment, and trends over time.

CD4-Positive T Cell

A type of white blood cell that coordinates immune responses. Different CD4 cells help activate other immune cells, support antibody production, defend mucosal surfaces, or limit excessive inflammation.

CD8-Positive T Cell

A type of white blood cell that recognizes abnormal signals on infected or altered cells. Cytotoxic CD8 cells can destroy virus-infected, cancerous, or otherwise abnormal cells.

Cd Antigens

Proteins or other markers on the surface of cells that help identify cell types, especially immune cells.

Laboratory antibodies against these markers can classify cells, diagnose blood disorders, and guide selected treatments.

C. Diff

Alternate index label; see *C. Difficile Infection*.

C. Difficile

Clostridioides difficile is a spore-forming bacterium that can multiply in the bowel, especially after antibiotics disrupt normal bacteria. Its toxins cause watery diarrhea and colon inflammation, which can become severe or recur.

C. Difficile Colitis

Inflammation of the colon caused by a *Clostridioides difficile* infection. It can cause diarrhea and abdominal pain; severe cases may develop pseudomembranous colitis. See *C. Difficile Infection*.

C. Difficile Infection

An acute infectious toxin-mediated colitis caused by the spore-forming, gram-positive anaerobic bacillus *Clostridioides difficile* (formerly *Clostridium difficile*). Precipitated primarily by antibiotic exposure (e.g., fluoroquinolones, clindamycin, broad-spectrum cephalosporins, carbapenems) which disrupts the normal protective gut microbiome, facilitating spore germination and vegetative cell proliferation. Pathogenicity is driven by the production of large clostridial exotoxins: Toxin A (enterotoxin) and Toxin B (potent cytotoxin), which disrupt actin cytoskeleton and tight junctions of colonocytes via Rho GTPase glucosylation, causing intense mucosal inflammation, pseudomembrane formation (yellow-white mucosal plaques composed of fibrin, mucin, and neutrophils), and watery diarrhea. Clinical spectrum ranges from mild self-limited diarrhea to fulminant pseudomembranous colitis, toxic megacolon, bowel perforation, and septic shock. Diagnosis requires a two-step laboratory algorithm: glutamate dehydrogenase (GDH) antigen enzyme immunoassay combined with sensitive nucleic acid amplification testing (NAAT) for toxin genes and toxin A/B enzyme immunoassay. First-line medical therapy consists of oral fidaxomicin or oral vancomycin, with fecal microbiota transplantation (FMT) reserved for recurrent refractory episodes.

Alternate Names:
Clostridioides Difficile Infection; CDI; Pseudomembranous Colitis

Cea

An abbreviation for carcinoembryonic antigen, a blood marker used mainly to monitor selected cancers rather than to screen people without symptoms.

CEA Assay

A laboratory test measuring carcinoembryonic antigen in a specimen, usually blood. It is mainly used to monitor selected known cancers and cannot diagnose or exclude cancer by itself.

CEA Blood Test

A blood test measuring carcinoembryonic antigen, used mainly to monitor selected cancers such as colorectal cancer and assess treatment response or recurrence. Smoking, inflammation, and other noncancerous conditions can also raise it.

Cebocephaly

A rare congenital malformation within the holoprosencephaly spectrum, marked by a small, flattened nose with a single nostril and closely spaced eyes, usually with major brain abnormalities.

Cecal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the caecum, the first part of the large intestine. Causes include inflammation, infection, reduced blood flow, polyps, diverticular disease, or cancer and may produce blood in the stool or anemia.

Cecal Infection

Infection of the caecum, the first part of the large intestine. It may cause right-sided abdominal pain, fever, diarrhea, or tenderness. The cause and treatment depend on the infection.

Cecal Neoplasm

A noncancerous or cancerous growth arising in the

caecum. It may cause bleeding, anemia, abdominal pain, altered bowel habits, or blockage and is usually evaluated with colonoscopy and tissue sampling.

Cecal Volvulus

Twisting of the caecum and nearby colon around the tissue that supports them, causing large-bowel blockage. It can produce sudden abdominal pain, swelling, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas and may cause bowel ischemia or perforation.

Cecostomy

A surgically created opening from the caecum to the abdominal wall to release pressure, drain bowel contents, or divert stool. It may be temporary or permanent depending on the underlying problem.

Cecum

The first pouch-like part of the large intestine, in the lower right abdomen where the small intestine joins the colon. The appendix arises from it; disease can include inflammation, tumors, bleeding, or twisting that blocks the bowel.

Cedar Leaf Oil Poisoning

Toxic exposure to cedar-leaf oil, usually after swallowing or inhaling it. It may irritate the mouth, stomach, lungs, or nervous system and can cause vomiting, dizziness, seizures, or breathing problems.

Cefaclor

A second-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible bacterial infections. It can cause allergic reactions, nausea, diarrhea, or antibiotic-associated colitis.

Cefadroxil

An oral first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible skin, throat, urinary, and other infections. Possible effects include allergy, nausea, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis.

Cefamandole

A second-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used in some settings for susceptible bacterial infections. It can cause allergy or diarrhea and may increase bleeding risk, especially in people with poor nutrition or liver disease.

Cefatrizine

An older oral cephalosporin antibiotic used in some countries for susceptible bacterial infections. Its usefulness depends on local availability, bacterial resistance, allergy risk, and current treatment guidance.

Cefazolin

An injectable first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible infections and commonly given before surgery to prevent infection. Allergy, diarrhea, and dose adjustment in kidney disease may be important.

Cefdinir

An oral third-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible respiratory, skin, and other infections. It may cause diarrhea, nausea, allergic reactions, or antibiotic-associated colitis and can interact with iron-containing products.

Cefepime

An injectable fourth-generation cephalosporin used for serious infections caused by susceptible bacteria, including some hospital-acquired infections. Kidney-dose adjustment is important because accumulation can cause confusion, seizures, or other neurologic toxicity.

Cefixime

An oral third-generation cephalosporin used for selected susceptible urinary, respiratory, ear, and other bacterial infections. It can cause diarrhea or allergy, and unnecessary use promotes antibiotic resistance.

Cefmenoxime

An injectable third-generation cephalosporin used in some countries for susceptible bacterial infections. Possible effects include allergic reactions, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis.

Cefmetazole

An injectable cephamycin antibiotic used in some countries for selected abdominal, pelvic, and other infections caused by susceptible bacteria. Allergy, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis are possible.

Cefonicid

A long-acting second-generation cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible infections. Its use is limited in many places; dose selection depends on kidney function, local resistance, and the infection site.

Cefoperazone

A third-generation cephalosporin active against many gram-negative bacteria and sometimes combined with a beta-lactamase inhibitor. It can cause allergy, diarrhea, bleeding, or impaired bile flow and requires appropriate monitoring.

Cefotaxime

An injectable third-generation cephalosporin used for serious susceptible infections, including meningitis, pneumonia, bloodstream infection, and sepsis. Allergy, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis are possible.

Cefotetan

An injectable cephamycin antibiotic used for selected serious infections and surgical prevention. It covers some anaerobic bacteria but can cause allergy, diarrhea, bleeding, or a reaction if alcohol is consumed around treatment.

Cefotiam

A second-generation cephalosporin used in some countries for susceptible respiratory, urinary, skin, and other bacterial infections. Allergy, gastrointestinal effects, and antibiotic-associated colitis are possible.

Cefoxitin

An injectable cephamycin antibiotic used for selected abdominal, pelvic, skin, and other infections, including some involving anaerobic bacteria. Allergy, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis can occur.

Ceftazidime

An injectable third-generation cephalosporin with activity against Pseudomonas aeruginosa and other susceptible gram-negative bacteria. It is used for selected serious infections and can cause allergy, diarrhea, or neurologic effects when it accumulates in kidney disease.

Ceftazidime-Avibactam

A combination antibiotic in which avibactam blocks some bacterial enzymes that destroy ceftazidime. It is used for selected difficult gram-negative infections, including some resistant organisms; kidney-dose adjustment and susceptibility testing are important.

Ceftibuten

An oral cephalosporin antibiotic used for selected susceptible respiratory, urinary, and other bacterial infections. It may cause diarrhea or allergy, and inappropriate use promotes resistance and antibiotic-associated colitis.

Ceftizoxime

An injectable third-generation cephalosporin used for selected serious infections caused by susceptible bacteria, including some abdominal, pelvic, urinary, and anaerobic infections. Allergy, diarrhea, and antibiotic-associated colitis are possible.

Ceftriaxone

An injectable third-generation cephalosporin used for many serious susceptible bacterial infections, including meningitis, pneumonia, bloodstream infection, and gonorrhea. Allergy, diarrhea, biliary problems, and antibiotic-associated colitis are possible.

Cefuroxime

A second-generation cephalosporin available by mouth or injection for selected respiratory, ear, urinary, skin, and other bacterial infections. It can cause allergy, nausea, diarrhea, or antibiotic-associated colitis.

Celiac Artery

A major branch of the abdominal aorta that supplies the upper digestive organs, including the stomach, liver, gallbladder, spleen, pancreas, and first part of the small intestine. It divides into the left gastric, splenic, and common hepatic arteries.

Celiac Crisis

A rare, severe complication of celiac disease marked by profuse diarrhea or vomiting, dehydration, and major electrolyte disturbances. It can progress to low blood pressure, confusion, or shock.

Celiac Disease

An inherited autoimmune disorder in which eating gluten—a protein found in wheat, barley, and rye—triggers an abnormal immune reaction that attacks and damages the lining of the small intestine. Over time, the immune attack flattens the tiny finger-like projections (villi) that absorb nutrients, leading to digestive issues such as chronic diarrhea, abdominal bloating, and weight loss, as well as malnourishment, iron deficiency, and fatigue.

Celiac Plexus

A network of nerves in the upper abdomen that carries signals to and from the stomach, liver, pancreas, intestines, and other organs. It can be targeted with an injection for selected severe abdominal pain.

Celiac Sprue

Alternate name; see *Celiac Disease*.

Celiac Trunk

The first major branch of the abdominal aorta, supplying the upper digestive organs. It divides into the left gastric, splenic, and common hepatic arteries and is surrounded by nerves of the celiac plexus.

Celiac Trunk Stenosis

Narrowing of the celiac trunk, caused by plaque or, in some people, compression by the diaphragm's median arcuate ligament. It may cause upper abdominal pain after meals and weight loss, although imaging findings do not always explain symptoms.

Cell

The smallest living unit that can perform life processes. Human cells usually contain DNA in a nucleus and specialized internal structures that produce energy, make proteins, communicate, and maintain the body's tissues.

Cell Adhesion

The attachment of cells to one another or to the supporting material around them. It helps maintain tissue structure, transmit signals, guide movement, and organize healing and development.

Cell Aggregation

Clumping of cells through interactions between their surfaces or surrounding proteins. It is important in development, immune responses, wound healing, and formation of blood clots.

Cell Body

The main part of a cell containing the nucleus and most internal structures. In a nerve cell, it excludes long extensions such as the axon and dendrites.

Alternate Names:
Perikaryon

Cell-Cell Junction

A specialized connection between neighboring cells that provides attachment, communication, or controlled passage of substances. Examples include tight junctions, desmosomes, and gap junctions.

Cell-Cell Signaling

The ways cells send and receive messages through direct contact, electrical activity, or chemicals such as hormones and neurotransmitters. Signaling coordinates growth, movement, immune responses, repair, and other body functions.

Cell Count

The number of cells in a sample of blood, body fluid, tissue, or laboratory culture. It helps assess blood-cell levels, inflammation, infection, immune function, or abnormal cell growth.

Cell Culture

Growth of cells outside the body in a controlled nutrient environment. It is used for research, medicine testing, diagnosis, production of biological products, and study of how cells respond to disease or treatment.

Cell Cycle

The series of stages through which a cell grows, copies its DNA, checks for damage, and divides into two cells. Disruption of cycle control can contribute to developmental disorders and cancer.

Cell Death

The loss of a cell's ability to remain alive. It may be a controlled process that removes old or damaged cells, or an uncontrolled result of injury, infection, toxins, lack of oxygen, or severe disease.

Cell Dedifferentiation

Loss of some specialized features by a mature cell, making it more like an immature cell. It can occur during repair or development and may contribute to abnormal growth in some cancers.

Cell Density

The number of cells in a given area or volume of tissue or fluid. It can change with growth, inflammation, healing, infection, or cancer and is measured in laboratory samples and tissue studies.

Cell Differentiation

The process by which an unspecialized cell develops the structure and function of a specialized cell type, such as a nerve, muscle, blood, or skin cell.

Cell Division

The process by which one cell produces new cells. Mitosis makes most body cells for growth and repair, while meiosis makes reproductive cells with half the usual number of chromosomes.

Cell-Free DNA

Non-encapsulated extracellular DNA fragments circulating freely in blood plasma or other biofluids, released from apoptotic or necrotic cells; analyzed in non-invasive prenatal screening (NIPT) and oncology liquid biopsies.

Alternate Names:
cfDNA; Circulating Cell-Free DNA

Cell-Free Fetal DNA Screening

A prenatal blood screening test that analyzes cell-free DNA fragments in a pregnant person's blood; a small fraction comes from the placenta and reflects fetal chromosomes. It estimates the chance of common chromosome number conditions, including trisomies 21, 18, and 13, but does not diagnose them. A high-risk or no-call result may be followed by counseling and diagnostic testing.

Alternate Names:
Cell-Free Fetal DNA Test; Cell-Free DNA Prenatal Screening; NIPT; NIPS

Cell-Free Fetal Test

Alternate name; see *Cell-Free Fetal DNA Screening*.

Cell Fusion

Joining of two cells or their outer membranes to form one larger cell, sometimes with several nuclei. It occurs in normal development and repair and can also occur during infection or disease.

Cell Growth

Increase in a cell's size and contents through production of proteins, membranes, energy stores, and other components. Abnormal growth signals can contribute to tissue overgrowth or cancer.

Cell-Matrix Junction

A specialized connection anchoring a cell to the supporting material around it. It also transmits signals that influence cell shape, movement, survival, and tissue organization.

Cell Maturation

Development of an immature cell into a mature cell with a specialized structure and function. It is essential for producing healthy blood, nerve, muscle, immune, and other body cells.

Cell-Mediated Immune Response

Alternate name; see *Cell-Mediated Immunity*.

Cell-Mediated Immunity

Immune defense carried out mainly by T lymphocytes and other cells rather than by antibodies. It is important for controlling infected cells, cancer cells, and organisms that live inside cells.

Cell Migration

Movement of cells through tissue or across a surface in response to chemical, mechanical, or environmental signals. It is important in development, immune defense, wound healing, and cancer spread.

Cell Motility

The ability of cells to move through or across a surface using their internal framework, attachment structures, or specialized projections such as cilia and flagella. It supports development, immunity, wound healing, and cancer spread.

Alternate Names:
Cell Locomotion

Cell Movement

Directed or random movement of a cell through tissue or across a surface. It is important in development, immune responses, wound repair, inflammation, and the spread of cancer.

Cell Nucleus

The membrane-covered compartment containing most of a cell's DNA. It helps control gene activity, growth, division, repair, and production of proteins needed for normal cell function.

Cellophane

A thin, transparent film made from regenerated cellulose. It has been used as a temporary covering for burns and other wounds; the term names the material, not a specific modern dressing or medical device.

Cell Pellet

The concentrated layer of cells collected at the bottom of a tube after spinning a sample in a centrifuge. It may be removed for microscopic, genetic, chemical, or other laboratory testing.

Cell Physiology

The study of how cells obtain energy, transport substances, communicate, respond to signals, repair themselves, and perform specialized functions.

Cell Polarity

The unequal arrangement of structures and activities within a cell, giving it distinct sides or directions. It enables organized transport, signaling, movement, development, and tissue structure.

Cell Proliferation

Increase in cell number through repeated division. Normal proliferation supports growth and repair, while excessive or uncontrolled proliferation can cause tissue overgrowth, benign tumors, or cancer.

Cell Secretion

Release of substances made by cells, such as hormones, enzymes, nerve chemicals, mucus, or immune signals. Secretion supports communication, digestion, protection, movement, and regulation of body processes.

Cell Senescence

A state in which a cell remains active but permanently stops dividing, often because of aging, stress, or DNA damage. Senescent cells can help prevent cancer but may contribute to inflammation when they accumulate.

Alternate Names:
Cellular Senescence; Replicative Senescence

Cell Signaling

The process by which cells detect information through receptors and transmit signals inside the cell to change functions such as growth, movement, metabolism, or immune activity.

Cell Sorting

Separation of cells into groups according to features

such as size, density, surface markers, or fluorescence. It is used in research, diagnosis, blood-cell analysis, and preparation of selected cells for treatment.

Cell Structure

The arrangement of a cell's membrane, cytoplasm, nucleus, and internal structures. These parts work together to produce energy, make proteins, communicate, divide, and carry out specialized functions.

Cell Surface

The outer membrane of a cell and the molecules attached to it. It controls movement of substances, attachment, recognition, communication, and interactions with immune cells and surrounding tissue.

Cell Survival

The ability of a cell to remain alive and functional despite injury, lack of nutrients, toxins, infection, or other stress. It depends on the cell type, the severity and duration of the stress, and the cell's repair systems.

Cell Therapy

Treatment that uses living cells to replace damaged cells, restore a function, or change an immune response. Uses range from established blood-forming stem-cell transplantation to experimental treatments; benefits and risks depend on the cells and disease.

Cell Transplantation

Transfer of living cells into a person to replace missing cells, restore tissue function, or modify immunity. Blood-forming stem-cell transplantation is established for selected diseases; rejection, infection, graft-versus-host disease, and other risks may occur.

Cellular

Relating to cells or to processes occurring within or between cells.

Cellular Adaptation

A reversible change in a cell's size, number, structure, or function in response to altered demands or mild injury. Adaptation may help a cell survive but can become harmful if the stress continues.

Cellular Immunity

Immune defense carried out mainly by T cells, natural killer cells, macrophages, and other cells rather than antibodies alone. It helps destroy infected or abnormal cells and control inflammation.

Cellular Metabolic Process

A chemical reaction or linked pathway in a cell that produces energy, builds cell components, or breaks down nutrients and waste.

Cellular Quiescence

A reversible, non-dividing physiological state in which a cell exits the active cell division cycle and enters the G0 phase in response to anti-mitogenic signals or nutrient deprivation, while retaining the capacity to re-enter the proliferative cycle upon appropriate growth factor stimulation.

Cellular Respiration

The process cells use to release energy from food. Most cells use oxygen to convert nutrients into ATP, the cell's usable energy, while limited energy can be made without oxygen.

Cellular Swelling

Early reversible cell injury in which failure of membrane pumps causes sodium and water to collect inside the cell. It commonly follows reduced blood flow, low oxygen, toxins, or other stresses.

Alternate Names:
Hydropic Change; Hydropic Degeneration; Cloudy Swelling

Cellular Vesicle

A small membrane-bound compartment that transports, stores, or releases substances inside or outside a cell. Vesicles help move proteins, fats, hormones, and waste.

Cellulite

A common harmless dimpled or uneven appearance

of skin, usually on the thighs, hips, or buttocks, caused by the arrangement of fat, connective tissue, and skin. It is different from cellulitis, a bacterial infection.

Cellulitis

A bacterial infection of the deeper skin and tissue beneath it, causing spreading redness, warmth, swelling, tenderness, and sometimes fever or chills. It commonly follows a break in the skin and can spread rapidly or enter the bloodstream.

Cellulomonas

A group of bacteria found mainly in soil, plants, and other environmental materials. They break down cellulose; human infection is rare and usually occurs opportunistically in people with severe illness or weakened immunity.

Cellulomonas Hominis

A rare environmental bacterium that has occasionally caused human infection, usually in people with weakened immunity or serious underlying illness. Its significance depends on symptoms, the body site, and laboratory identification.

Cellulose

A complex carbohydrate forming the structure of plant cell walls. Humans cannot digest it, but it is dietary fiber that adds bulk to stool and can support regular bowel movements when enough fluid is consumed.

Cellulosimicrobium

A group of environmental bacteria found mainly in soil. Human infection is rare but may affect people with serious illness, implanted devices, or weakened immune defenses and can involve the blood, heart, or other tissues.

Cellulosome

A group of enzymes joined together by some microorganisms to break down cellulose in plant cell walls. It helps the organism digest plant material and is studied for biotechnology and biofuel production.

Cell Wall

A rigid outer layer surrounding plant, fungal, and bacterial cells. It provides shape and protection; human and animal cells have a flexible membrane but no cell wall.

Celosomy

A rare birth defect involving incomplete closure of the body wall, allowing abdominal or chest organs to protrude outside the body. The term is used for severe omphalocele-like malformations and requires specialist newborn care.

Cement

A material used to fill spaces or attach an artificial joint or other prosthesis to bone. Dental cement bonds or protects dental work; the appropriate type depends on the procedure.

Cemento-Enamel Junction

The boundary where tooth enamel covering the crown meets cementum covering the root. Its shape varies, and an exposed junction may be sensitive or more vulnerable to decay.

Cementoma

A usually noncancerous jaw lesion containing cementum-like mineralized tissue. Its behavior and treatment depend on the specific subtype, location, size, symptoms, and relationship to nearby teeth.

Cementum

A thin mineralized layer covering a tooth root. Fibers of the periodontal ligament attach to it and help anchor the tooth in its socket; it can be lost with gum disease.

Cenesthesia

The general awareness of one's body, including its condition, position, and internal sensations. Disturbance may occur in some neurologic or psychiatric illnesses and can alter how bodily sensations are experienced.

Centenarian

A person aged 100 years or older. Centenarians are a diverse group; some remain independent, while others need substantial support, and age alone does not determine health or cognitive ability.

Center

A central point, region, or facility organized around a function. In medicine, the term may describe an anatomical location, a treatment facility, or the middle of a measured structure.

Centigram

A metric unit of mass equal to one hundredth of a gram, or 10 milligrams, used for small quantities of medicines or specimens.

Centimeter

A metric unit of length equal to one hundredth of a meter, commonly used in clinical measurements such as wound size, tumor dimensions, and anatomical distances.

Centipede

A many-legged arthropod whose bite can inject venom and cause local pain, swelling, and redness; severe allergic reactions are uncommon but possible.

Centipoise

A unit of dynamic viscosity equal to one millipascal-second, used to describe the flow resistance of blood, fluids, medicines, and other materials.

Central

Located near the middle of the body or an organ, rather than near its edge. The word may describe a body structure, nervous-system area, blood line, symptom, or pattern of disease.

Central Apnea

A pause in breathing caused by absent or reduced respiratory effort from impaired brainstem signaling, rather than upper-airway obstruction.

Central Auditory Processing Disorder

Difficulty interpreting sounds in the brain despite adequate hearing. People may struggle to understand speech in noise, follow rapid instructions, identify sounds, or distinguish similar words.

Central Centrifugal Cicatricial Alopecia

A primary scarring hair-loss disorder that usually begins at the crown and expands outward. It is most common in women of African ancestry and may cause scalp tenderness, itching, or hair breakage. Inflammation destroys follicles, leading to permanent hair loss in affected areas.

Central Cord Syndrome

The most common form of incomplete traumatic spinal cord injury, typically resulting from hyperextension trauma in patients with preexisting cervical spondylosis. It is characterized by disproportionately greater motor weakness and impairment in the upper extremities compared to the lower extremities, accompanied by variable sensory loss and bladder dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Central Cord Syndrome; Schneider Syndrome

Central Core Disease

An inherited muscle disorder, often caused by an RYR1 gene change, that may cause low muscle tone, delayed motor development, and weakness. Some affected people can develop life-threatening overheating with certain anesthetics.

Alternate Names:
CCD; Core Myopathy; RYR1-Related Central Core Disease

Central Cyanosis

Bluish discoloration of the lips, tongue, or oral mucosa associated with reduced arterial oxygenation or abnormal hemoglobin. The often-quoted threshold of about 5 g/dL of deoxygenated hemoglobin refers to capillary blood and is approximate; visible cyanosis also depends on total hemoglobin concentration, perfusion, and other factors.

Central Deafness

Severe hearing loss caused by damage to sound-processing pathways or areas of the brain, rather than the outer, middle, or inner ear. Hearing tests may show poor understanding despite detected sounds.

Central Diabetes Insipidus

Excessive urination and intense thirst caused by too little antidiuretic hormone from the brain. The kidneys cannot conserve enough water, so dehydration and high blood sodium may develop.

Central Fatigue

Mental tiredness or reduced concentration linked to changes in how the brain and spinal cord process activity. It can occur with neurologic or long-term illness and is different from muscle weakness.

Alternate Names:
Mental Fatigue

Central Hypothyroidism

A condition with too little thyroid hormone because the brain's pituitary gland or hypothalamus does not provide enough stimulation to the thyroid.

Central Line

A catheter inserted into a large vein with its tip in or near the heart, used to give medications or nutrition, draw blood, or monitor central venous pressures.

Central Line-Associated Bloodstream Infection

A surveillance-defined primary bloodstream infection in a patient with a central line present within the preceding 48 hours, with no other identified infection source. This definition does not establish that the catheter caused the infection; a catheter-related bloodstream infection is a distinct clinical diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
CLABSI

Central Line Placement

Insertion of a catheter into a large vein, commonly in the neck, chest, or groin, with its tip near the heart. It allows long-term medicines, nutrition, fluids, blood sampling, or monitoring.

Central Nervous System

The brain and spinal cord. It receives and interprets information, controls movement and many automatic body functions, and supports thought, memory, emotion, and regulation of hormones.

Central Nervous System Germinoma

A malignant germ-cell tumor usually arising in the brain, often near the pineal or suprasellar region. It may cause headache, visual or endocrine abnormalities, hydrocephalus, or impaired puberty; MRI, tumor markers, and specialist evaluation are important.

Central Nervous System Lymphoma

A lymphoma involving the brain, spinal cord, cerebrospinal fluid, or eye that can cause neurologic or visual symptoms.

Central Nervous System Vascular Malformations

Abnormal groups or connections of blood vessels in or around the brain or spinal cord. Some cause no symptoms, while others can cause headaches, seizures, weakness, or bleeding; treatment depends on the type, size, location, and risk.

Central Neurofibromatosis

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 2*.

Central Pain Syndrome

Chronic pain caused by damage or dysfunction in the brain or spinal cord. Pain may be burning, aching, electric, or unusually sensitive to touch and may occur after stroke, spinal-cord injury, multiple sclerosis, or other lesions.

Central Placenta Previa

Older term for complete placenta previa; see *Pla-*

centa Previa.

Central Pontine Myelinolysis

Brain injury caused most often by correcting very low blood sodium too quickly. Damage in the pons may cause weakness, trouble speaking or swallowing, confusion, reduced consciousness, or locked-in syndrome.

Central Precocious Puberty

Central precocious puberty begins when the hypothalamus and pituitary activate the normal puberty pathway unusually early. It causes early secondary sexual characteristics and accelerated bone maturation; causes vary, and hormone-suppressing treatment can delay progression in selected cases.

Central Retinal Artery Occlusion

A sudden blockage of the main artery supplying the retina, causing severe, usually painless loss of vision in one eye. It is an eye stroke requiring emergency assessment for related vascular disease.

Central Retinal Vein Occlusion

A blockage in the main vein that drains blood from the retina, the light-sensitive layer at the back of the eye. It can cause sudden blurred or lost vision in one eye. Treatment depends on the effect on vision and the cause.

Central Serous Chorioretinopathy

A disorder in which fluid collects beneath the retina, usually at the macula, causing blurred or distorted central vision. It is associated with leakage from blood vessels in the choroid and dysfunction of the retinal pigment epithelium; corticosteroid exposure is a recognized risk factor.

Central Serous Choroidopathy

Alternate name for central serous chorioretinopathy; see *Central Serous Chorioretinopathy*.

Central Sleep Apnea

Repeated pauses in breathing during sleep because the brain temporarily stops sending signals to breathe, without physical airway blockage. It may occur with heart failure, high altitude, or opioid use.

Alternate Names:
CSA

Central Sleep Apnea Syndromes

Repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep caused by diminished respiratory drive rather than upper-airway blockage. Causes include heart failure, opioids, neurologic disease, high altitude, and treatment-emergent patterns; evaluation and therapy depend on the underlying mechanism.

Central Sulcus

A prominent anatomical landmark on the lateral cerebral cortex separating the precentral gyrus of the frontal lobe (primary motor cortex) from the postcentral gyrus of the parietal lobe (primary somatosensory cortex).

Alternate Names:
Rolandic Fissure; Sulcus of Rolando

Central Venous Catheter

A thin tube ending in a large vein near the heart. It provides reliable access for prolonged or irritating treatments and monitoring but can cause infection, blood clots, bleeding, or injury.

Central Venous Catheter Dressing Change

A standardized sterile nursing procedure involving the aseptic removal of existing catheter dressings, chlorhexidine-based antisepsis of the percutaneous exit site, and application of a sterile transparent semipermeable occlusive dressing.

Alternate Names:
CVC Dressing Change; Central Line Dressing Care; Catheter Site Dressing

Central Venous Catheter Flushing

The pulsatile instillation of sterile preservative-free 0.9% sodium chloride or heparinized lock solution through a central venous catheter lumen using positive pressure to prevent intraluminal thrombus formation, fibrin buildup, and catheter occlusion.

Alternate Names:
CVC Flushing; Central Line Heparin Lock; Catheter Patency Flushing

Central Venous Line

A vascular catheter whose tip lies in a major central vein, commonly the superior vena cava, for reliable long-term or high-concentration intravenous access.

Central Venous Pressure

Pressure measured in or near the right atrium, usually through a central venous catheter. It reflects right-sided filling conditions but is affected by ventilation, heart function, vascular tone, and measurement technique; it correlates imperfectly with circulating blood volume and fluid responsiveness.

Central Vertigo

Dizziness or an illusion of motion caused by dysfunction in the brainstem, cerebellum, or central vestibular pathways. It may occur with neurologic signs, severe imbalance, or less position-dependent symptoms.

Central Vision

Detailed vision directed at the point of gaze, provided primarily by the macula and fovea; it is needed for reading and recognizing faces.

Centriacinar Emphysema

A form of emphysema in which damage begins in the small airways and nearby air sacs, usually in the upper lungs. It is strongly linked to smoking and can cause cough, wheezing, breathlessness, and reduced exercise ability.

Centric-Fusion Translocation

A Robertsonian translocation in which the long arms of two acrocentric chromosomes fuse near their centromeres, leaving a combined chromosome and usually losing the short arms.

Centrifugation

Spinning a specimen at high speed to separate components by density, such as cells from plasma or precipitated material from a liquid.

Centrifuge

A machine that spins samples rapidly to separate their parts by density. Laboratories use it to separate blood cells from plasma, concentrate urine material, or prepare tissue samples for testing; speed is recorded in revolutions or relative force.

Centrilobular Emphysema

A type of permanent lung damage in which the small airways and nearby air sacs are destroyed, usually from long-term smoking or inhaled irritants. It often affects the upper lungs and can cause breathlessness, cough, wheezing, and reduced ability to exercise.

Alternate Names:
Centriacinar Emphysema; Proximal Acinar Emphysema

Centriole

A cylindrical microtubule structure in the centrosome that helps organize the mitotic spindle and, in some cells, forms the basal body of a cilium or flagellum.

Centromere

The constricted chromosome region where sister chromatids remain attached and the kinetochore forms for accurate chromosome segregation during cell division.

Centronuclear Myopathy

A group of inherited muscle diseases in which muscle fibers develop abnormally. Symptoms range from severe weakness and breathing problems at birth to milder adult-onset weakness, often affecting the shoulders, hips, eyelids, eye movements, face, or feet.

Alternate Names:
CNM; Myotubular Myopathy (General)

Centrosome

The main microtubule-organizing center of an animal cell, containing a pair of centrioles and coordinating the spindle during mitosis.

Centrum

The main body of a vertebra, located in front of the spinal canal. It bears much of the body's weight and joins neighboring vertebrae through shock-absorbing discs.

Cephacetrile

An older first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis; it is not commonly used in current practice.

Cephalalgia

Headache or pain in the head, including pain arising from cranial or related structures. It is a symptom with many possible primary and secondary causes.

Cephalexin

An oral first-generation cephalosporin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats selected skin, respiratory, urinary, and other susceptible infections.

Cephalgia

Alternate spelling; see *Headache*.

Cephalhaematoma

A collection of blood beneath the membrane covering a newborn's skull bone, usually caused by birth-related pressure or injury. It is limited by skull sutures and usually resolves without treatment.

Cephalhematoma

A traumatic subperiosteal collection of blood over a neonatal cranial bone, commonly the parietal bone, resulting from rupture of periosteal blood vessels during delivery; clinically distinguished from caput succedaneum by remaining strictly bounded by cranial suture lines.

Cephalic

Relating to the head or toward the head; in obstetrics, a cephalic presentation means the fetus presents head first.

Cephalic Vein

A superficial vein on the lateral side of the upper limb that drains the hand and forearm and joins the axillary vein near the shoulder.

Cephalohematoma

A collection of blood trapped under the outer layer of a newborn's skull bone, usually caused by pressure during a long labor or delivery with vacuum suction or forceps. Because the blood is held tightly to a single bone, the swelling stays on one side of the head and does not cross the skull's bone seams (sutures). It is usually harmless and shrinks away on its own within a few weeks, though the breaking down of trapped blood can sometimes cause mild newborn jaundice.

Alternate Names:
Cephalhematoma; Cephalohaematoma.

Cephalometry

Measurement of the skull and facial structures, usually on standardized radiographs, used in orthodontic planning and assessment of craniofacial growth.

Cephalopelvic Disproportion

A situation in which the fetal head cannot pass easily through the mother's pelvis because of their relative size or shape. It may prevent vaginal delivery, but cannot always be confirmed before labor.

Cephaloridine

An older injectable first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic whose use declined because of nephrotoxicity and the availability of safer alternatives.

Cephalosporin

A bactericidal beta-lactam antibiotic that inhibits bacterial cell wall synthesis by covalently binding penicillin-binding proteins (PBPs), disrupting peptidoglycan transpeptidation. Structured on a 7-aminocephalosporanic acid nucleus, cephalosporins are divided into five generations: first generation (cefazolin, cephalexin; primarily gram-positive cocci); second (cefuroxime, cefoxitin, cefotetan; added gram-negative and anaerobes); third (ceftriaxone, ceftazidime; potent gram-negative cov-

erage and CNS penetration); fourth (cefepime; broad-spectrum with pseudomonal coverage); and fifth (ceftaroline; active against methicillin-resistant *Staphylococcus aureus* [MRSA]). Adverse effects include hypersensitivity reactions, drug-induced immune hemolytic anemia, and predisposition to *Clostridioides difficile* infection.

Cephalosporins
Plural form; see *Cephalosporin*.

Cephalothin
An older injectable first-generation cephalosporin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and was used for susceptible serious infections.

Cephapirin
A first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic formerly used for susceptible bacterial infections; current availability and indications vary by country.

Cephradine
A first-generation cephalosporin antibiotic related to cephalexin that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats selected susceptible infections.

Ceramide
A type of fat that forms part of cell membranes and helps the outer skin retain water and block irritants. Ceramides also participate in signals controlling cell growth and survival.

Cercaria
A cercaria is a free-swimming larval stage of a trematode parasite; contact with some species can cause swimmer's itch or other infection.

Cercarial Dermatitis
Alternate name; see *Swimmer's Itch*.

Cerclage
A procedure in which a strong stitch is placed around the cervix to help prevent it opening too early during pregnancy. It may be placed through the vagina or abdomen and requires obstetric follow-up.

Cerebellar
Relating to the cerebellum, the part of the brain that helps coordinate balance, posture, eye movements, and accurate movement. Cerebellar disease may cause clumsiness, tremor, or unsteady walking.

Cerebellar Ataxia
Poor coordination caused by disease or injury affecting the cerebellum or its connections. It may cause an unsteady walk, clumsy movements, slurred speech, tremor, or abnormal eye movements.

Cerebellar Cortex
The folded outer layer of the cerebellum containing Purkinje and granular neurons that coordinates balance, posture, timing, and precision of movement.

Cerebellar Disease
A disorder of the cerebellum causing impaired coordination, gait ataxia, dysmetria, tremor, abnormal eye movements, or speech changes.

Cerebellar Dysmetria
Inaccurate control of the distance or force of a movement because of cerebellar dysfunction. A person may reach past a target, stop short, or have difficulty judging movement size.

Cerebellar Hemangioblastoma
A usually benign, highly vascular tumor of the cerebellum that may cause headache, imbalance, vomiting, or hydrocephalus and can occur with von Hippel-Lindau disease.

Cerebellar Hypoplasia
Incomplete development of the cerebellum, usually beginning before birth. It may cause poor coordination, abnormal eye movements, seizures, delayed development, or problems with balance and movement.

Cerebellar Neoplasm
A benign or malignant tumor involving the cerebel-

lum; symptoms may include poor coordination, imbalance, abnormal eye movements, headache, vomiting, or hydrocephalus.

Cerebellar Nuclei

Deep clusters of cerebellar neurons that receive processed signals from the cerebellar cortex and send coordinated motor output to the brainstem and thalamus.

Cerebellar Peduncle

One of three pairs of large, compact white matter fiber tracts (superior, middle, and inferior cerebellar peduncles) that physically and functionally connect the cerebellum to the midbrain, pons, and medulla oblongata, respectively.

Cerebellar Tonsillar Herniation

The life-threatening downward displacement of the cerebellar tonsils through the foramen magnum into the upper cervical spinal canal, causing direct compression of the cardiorespiratory and vasomotor centers of the medulla oblongata.

Alternate Names:
Coning; Tonsillar Herniation

Cerebellar Tumor

A growth in or near the cerebellum that may cause poor coordination, unsteady walking, abnormal eye movements, vomiting, or pressure buildup.

Cerebellar Vermis

The midline portion of the cerebellum that helps control trunk posture, gait, balance, and coordination of eye and head movements.

Cerebellitis

Inflammation of the cerebellum, often after an infection and sometimes from an immune reaction. It may cause sudden poor coordination, unsteady walking, slurred speech, abnormal eye movements, headache, or reduced alertness.

Cerebellopontine Angle

The angle-shaped region at the junction of the cerebellum, pons, and petrous temporal bone. Lesions in this space may affect cranial nerves and commonly include vestibular schwannoma.

Cerebellopontine Angle Tumor

A growth in the space between the cerebellum and brainstem. It may press on nerves that control hearing, balance, facial movement, or sensation and cause hearing loss, dizziness, facial weakness, headache, or poor coordination.

Cerebellum

A region at the back of the brain, behind the brainstem, that coordinates balance, posture, eye movements, and accurate voluntary movement. Injury or disease can cause unsteady walking, clumsy movements, tremor, or slurred speech.

Cerebral

Relating to the cerebrum or, more broadly, to the brain.

Cerebral Amyloid Angiopathy

A brain small-vessel disease, usually affecting older adults, in which amyloid—usually amyloid-beta—builds up in the walls of small and medium-sized vessels in the cerebral cortex and the membranes covering the brain. The deposits make vessels fragile and can cause bleeding in the brain's outer regions (lobar hemorrhage) or smaller bleeds (microbleeds). The disease may also cause brief episodes of neurologic symptoms or cognitive impairment. It can occur with Alzheimer disease, but the two conditions are distinct.

Cerebral Aneurysm

An abnormal focal enlargement of an artery in or around the brain. It may remain asymptomatic or rupture and cause subarachnoid hemorrhage. Risk factors include hypertension, smoking, certain inherited disorders, and family history.

Cerebral Angiography

An X-ray test in which contrast dye is put into an artery to make the blood vessels of the brain visible. It can show aneurysms, abnormal artery-to-vein

connections, narrowing, or blockage and is usually done with a thin tube called a catheter.

Cerebral Aqueduct

A narrow channel through the midbrain connecting the third and fourth brain ventricles. It allows cerebrospinal fluid to flow, and blockage can enlarge the ventricles and increase pressure.

Cerebral Arteriovenous Malformation

Alternate name; see *Brain Arteriovenous Malformation*.

Cerebral Artery

An artery that carries blood to part of the brain. A blockage can cause an ischemic stroke, while a break in the vessel can cause bleeding in or around the brain; the effects depend on which artery is involved.

Cerebral Atrophy

Loss or shrinkage of brain tissue, which may occur with aging, disease, injury, infection, or stroke. It is a finding, not a diagnosis by itself; its meaning depends on how much tissue has changed, where it has changed, and the person's symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Brain Atrophy

Cerebral Autoregulation

The brain's ability to keep its blood flow relatively steady when blood pressure changes. This control can fail after severe brain injury, stroke, low oxygen, high carbon dioxide, or effects from some medicines.

Cerebral Calcification

Abnormal calcium deposition in brain tissue, with causes including inherited, metabolic, infectious, vascular, and age-related disorders.

Cerebral Cavernous Malformation

A low-flow, angiographically occult vascular malformation of the central nervous system composed of a compact cluster of endothelial-lined sinusoidal spaces (caverns) engorged with blood, lacking intervening normal brain parenchyma, elastic lamina, or smooth muscle. May occur sporadically or as an autosomal dominant familial disorder linked to mutations in *KRIT1* (CCM1), *CCM2*, or *PDCD10* (CCM3). Manifestations include seizures, persistent headaches, focal neurologic deficits, and recurrent intraparenchymal microhemorrhages. On MRI, lesions display a characteristic reticulated "popcorn" appearance with a blooming rim of hemosiderin hypointensity on T2- and susceptibility-weighted imaging.

Cerebral Cavernous Malformations

Plural form; see *Cerebral Cavernous Malformation*.

Cerebral Cortex

The folded outer layer of the cerebrum containing nerve cells that support thinking, sensation, movement, language, memory, and awareness. Its folds increase the amount of working brain tissue within the skull.

Cerebral Crus

A bundle of nerve fibers in the midbrain that carries movement signals from the brain's outer layer toward the brainstem and spinal cord. Damage can cause weakness or poor control on the opposite side.

Cerebral Diplegia

A form of cerebral palsy in which stiffness and weakness affect both legs more than the arms. It can make standing, walking, balance, and other movements difficult.

Cerebral Edema

Swelling caused by excess fluid in or around brain tissue. It can raise pressure inside the skull, reduce blood flow, and cause headache, vomiting, confusion, seizures, coma, or life-threatening brain displacement.

Cerebral Embolism

Alternate name; see *Embolic Stroke*.

Cerebral Haemorrhage

Bleeding in or around the brain caused by a damaged blood vessel. It can injure brain tissue, increase pressure inside the skull, and cause sudden headache, weakness, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Cerebral Hemisphere

One of the two large halves of the cerebrum, each containing specialized but interconnected cortical regions.

Cerebral Hemorrhage

Bleeding into brain tissue, usually from a damaged blood vessel. It can injure nearby brain cells, cause swelling and pressure, and produce sudden weakness, speech trouble, headache, reduced alertness, or death.

Cerebral Hypoxia

Too little oxygen reaching the brain, often because of cardiac arrest, severe breathing failure, low blood pressure, or choking. Prolonged oxygen shortage can permanently injure brain cells.

Cerebral Infarction

Permanent brain injury caused by blocked blood flow in a brain artery. The blockage may result from a clot formed in a narrowed artery or a clot traveling from the heart or another vessel.

Cerebral Ischemia

Reduced blood flow and oxygen reaching brain tissue. It may cause temporary symptoms, such as a transient ischemic attack, or permanent injury if the interruption lasts long enough.

Cerebral Lobes

Major regions of the cerebrum with different but overlapping functions: the frontal lobe supports planning and movement, the parietal sensation and spatial awareness, the temporal hearing and memory, and the occipital vision.

Cerebral Malaria

A life-threatening form of malaria in which parasites cause brain dysfunction, often with confusion, seizures, abnormal behavior, or coma. It is usually caused by Plasmodium falciparum.

Cerebral Palsy

A group of permanent disorders of movement and posture caused by nonprogressive disturbances in the developing brain. Motor limitations vary and may be accompanied by seizures, intellectual disability, communication or feeding problems, or vision, hearing, and musculoskeletal conditions. The brain disturbance does not progress, although symptoms and functional needs can change with age.

Alternate Names:
CP

Cerebral Peduncle

One of two bundles of nerve fibers in the midbrain that carry movement signals from the cerebrum to the brainstem and spinal cord. Damage can cause weakness or loss of coordinated movement on the opposite side.

Cerebral Perfusion Pressure

The pressure pushing blood through the brain, estimated from average arterial pressure minus pressure inside the skull. It falls when blood pressure drops or brain swelling raises skull pressure.

Cerebral Salt Wasting

Excessive loss of sodium and water in urine associated with brain injury or disease. It can cause low blood sodium and dehydration; replacement is guided by clinical and laboratory findings.

Cerebral Salt-Wasting Syndrome

A clinical disorder of hyponatremia and extracellular fluid volume depletion occurring in acute central nervous system disease (such as subarachnoid hemorrhage or head trauma), characterized by renal natriuresis, polyuria, and true intravascular hypovolemia.

Alternate Names:
CSWS

Cerebral Schistosomiasis

A rare form of schistosomiasis in which parasite eggs, most often from *Schistosoma japonicum*, reach the brain and trigger inflammation with granuloma formation. Depending on the affected area, it may cause headache, seizures, confusion, vision changes, or weakness. Diagnosis combines brain imaging with tests for schistosome infection, such as examination of stool or urine for eggs or blood antibody tests; brain biopsy may be needed when the diagnosis remains uncertain.

Cerebral Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot within a cerebral artery, reducing blood flow and potentially causing an ischemic stroke.

Cerebral Toxoplasmosis

A severe, life-threatening opportunistic central nervous system infection caused by the reactivation of latent Toxoplasma gondii tissue cysts, occurring almost exclusively in patients with advanced cellular immunodeficiency (such as individuals with AIDS with CD4 counts below 100 cells/μL or recipients of organ transplants). It presents with progressive headache, fever, altered mental status, seizures, and focal neurological deficits, with contrast neuroimaging characteristically revealing multiple ring-enhancing brain lesions with surrounding vasogenic edema predominantly in the basal ganglia and corticomedullary junction.

Alternate Names:
Toxoplasma Encephalitis; CNS Toxoplasmosis; Toxoplasmic Encephalitis

Cerebral Tumor

An abnormal growth in or involving the brain. Symptoms depend on its location, size, growth, and effect on pressure inside the skull and may include headache, seizures, weakness, or changes in thinking.

Cerebral Tumours

Abnormal growths in the cerebrum, the largest part of the brain. They may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause seizures, headache, changes in thinking, weakness, speech problems, or vision changes.

Cerebral Vasospasm

Abnormal narrowing of cerebral arteries that can reduce brain perfusion and cause delayed cerebral ischemia, especially after aneurysmal subarachnoid hemorrhage.

Cerebral Venous Sinus Thrombosis

A blood clot in a large vein or drainage channel of the brain. It can cause headache, seizures, visual problems, weakness, brain bleeding, or increased pressure inside the skull.

Cerebral Ventricle

One of four interconnected fluid-filled internal cavities of the brain (paired lateral ventricles, midline third ventricle, and fourth ventricle) lined by ependymal cells and containing choroid plexuses that synthesize cerebrospinal fluid (CSF). CSF circulates from the lateral ventricles through the interventricular foramina of Monro into the third ventricle, traverses the cerebral aqueduct of Sylvius into the fourth ventricle, and exits via the foramina of Luschka and Magendie into the subarachnoid space, providing mechanical buoyancy, hydrostatic cushioning, and biochemical waste clearance.

Alternate Names:
Cerebral Ventricles; Ventricular System

Cerebral Ventricles

Plural form; see *Cerebral Ventricle*.

Cerebral Ventriculography

Imaging of the brain's fluid-filled ventricles to assess their size, shape, connections, or blockage. Modern scans usually use computed tomography or magnetic resonance imaging rather than older invasive methods.

Cerebral Ventriculomegaly

Enlargement of one or more fluid-filled spaces inside the brain. It may result from blocked fluid drainage, loss of brain tissue, or developmental variation; its importance depends on the cause and severity.

Cerebral Visual Impairment

Reduced vision caused by damage to the brain's visual pathways or visual-processing areas rather than the eyes. It may cause poor visual attention, difficulty recognizing objects, or inconsistent use of vision.

Cerebriform Nevus Sebaceous

A usually harmless birthmark made of overgrown oil glands, often on the scalp or face, with a soft, folded surface resembling the brain. It can rarely develop another tumor, so persistent or changing lesions need review.

Cerebritis

Inflammation and infection of brain tissue before a definite abscess forms, usually caused by bacteria, fungi, or parasites. It can cause headache, fever, seizures, or neurologic deficits; imaging may show inflammation before a defined abscess forms.

Cerebroplacental Ratio

The ratio of the fetal middle cerebral artery and umbilical artery pulsatility indices, measured by Doppler ultrasound. Each index summarizes changes in blood-flow speed during the heartbeat. A low ratio for gestational age can indicate redistribution of blood flow toward the fetal brain in response to reduced placental oxygen supply; the ratio is interpreted with fetal growth and other Doppler findings.

Cerebrosides

Fat-containing substances found especially in the membranes and protective coverings of nerve cells. They help maintain nerve structure and are broken down abnormally in some inherited storage diseases.

Cerebrospinal Fluid

A clear fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord and filling spaces inside the brain. It cushions the nervous system, helps carry nutrients and waste, and is continuously produced and reabsorbed by the body.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Fluid

Cerebrospinal Fluid Analysis

Laboratory examination of cerebrospinal fluid, usually obtained by lumbar puncture. It may assess infection, bleeding, inflammation, demyelinating disease, or malignant cells. Analysis can include opening pressure, appearance, cell counts, protein, glucose, microbiology, and other tests selected for the clinical question.

Cerebrospinal Fluid Collection

A procedure, usually lumbar puncture, that collects cerebrospinal fluid for laboratory analysis; it can help evaluate infection, bleeding, inflammation, malignancy, and other disorders of the central nervous system.

Cerebrospinal Fluid Culture

A laboratory test that attempts to grow bacteria, fungi, or other microorganisms from cerebrospinal fluid to investigate meningitis or another central nervous system infection. Results depend on prior antimicrobial treatment, specimen volume, transport, and the clinical context.

Cerebrospinal Fluid Cytology

Microscopic examination of cells in cerebrospinal fluid to evaluate suspected malignancy, infection, inflammation, or hemorrhage. It is especially useful for detecting leptomeningeal tumor involvement when interpreted with clinical and imaging findings.

Cerebrospinal Fluid Leak

Escape of cerebrospinal fluid through a tear in the membranes surrounding the brain or spinal cord, often causing positional headache.

Cerebrotendinous Xanthomatosis (CTX)

A rare inherited disorder of bile-acid synthesis, usually caused by *CYP27A1* variants. Cholesterol-derived substances accumulate in the brain, tendons, and other tissues and may cause cataracts, chronic diarrhea, tendon xanthomas, seizures, ataxia, or progressive neurologic disease.

Cerebrovascular

Relating to the brain's blood vessels and blood flow.

Cerebrovascular problems can reduce oxygen delivery and cause strokes, brief warning episodes, bleeding, or lasting problems with movement, speech, vision, or thinking.

Alternate Names:
Brain-Vascular; Cerebral Vascular

Cerebrovascular Accident

A stroke caused by a blocked brain artery or bleeding in the brain. It can suddenly cause weakness, numbness, trouble speaking, vision loss, confusion, severe headache, or loss of balance and requires emergency care.

Cerebrovascular Accident Prevention

Measures to reduce the risk of stroke, including controlling blood pressure, diabetes, and lipids, avoiding tobacco, treating atrial fibrillation when indicated, and using appropriate antithrombotic therapy.

Cerebrovascular Disease

A group of disorders affecting blood vessels and blood flow in the brain, including stroke, transient ischemic attack, aneurysm, and vascular malformations.

Cerebrovascular Disorder

A disorder of brain blood vessels or cerebral blood flow, including ischemia, hemorrhage, aneurysm, malformation, and venous thrombosis.

Cerebrovascular Occlusion

Blockage or closure of a blood vessel supplying the brain, reducing blood flow and potentially causing brain injury or an ischemic stroke.

Cerebrum

The largest part of the brain, made of two connected halves. It supports conscious movement, sensation, language, memory, thinking, emotions, and vision; different areas specialize in different functions.

Certification

A formal process confirming that a person, service, laboratory, or facility meets specified training, quality, safety, or professional standards.

Certified Nurse-Midwife

An advanced-practice nurse trained and credentialed to provide reproductive, pregnancy, birth, postpartum, and newborn care, including management of normal pregnancy and referral of complications.

Certolizumab Pegol

A biologic medicine that blocks tumor necrosis factor and treats selected inflammatory diseases, including rheumatoid arthritis and Crohn disease. It can increase the risk of serious infections.

Ceruloplasmin

The main protein that carries copper in the blood. It is made mostly by the liver; unusually low or high levels can occur in Wilson disease, inflammation, liver disease, or other conditions.

Alternate Names:
Caeruloplasmin

Ceruloplasmin Blood Test

A blood test measuring ceruloplasmin, the main copper-carrying protein in plasma; it is used with other copper studies to evaluate Wilson disease and disorders of copper metabolism.

Cerumen

Earwax, a waxy substance made in the ear canal. It traps dust and helps protect and moisturize the canal; too much can block hearing or cause discomfort.

Cerumen Impaction

Earwax packed tightly enough to block the ear canal or prevent examination of the eardrum. It may cause blocked hearing, pressure, ringing, itching, pain, or dizziness.

Alternate Names:
Earwax Impaction

Ceruminous Adenocarcinoma

A malignant tumor of the ceruminous glands in the

external ear canal that may cause pain, discharge, hearing loss, or a persistent ear-canal mass.

Cervical

Relating to the neck or to the cervix, the lower opening of the uterus. The meaning depends on context, such as cervical spine, cervical pain, or cervical cancer.

Cervical Adenocarcinoma

A malignant gland-forming tumor arising in the uterine cervix; it may be HPV-associated or HPV-independent and commonly presents with abnormal bleeding or discharge.

Cervical Arthritis

Degenerative or inflammatory disease of the neck joints that can cause neck pain, stiffness, reduced motion, and sometimes nerve or spinal-cord compression.

Cervical Atlas

The first bone of the neck, called C1. It is a ring-shaped vertebra that supports the skull and moves around the second neck vertebra when the head turns.

Cervical Biopsy

Removal of a small piece of tissue from the cervix for laboratory examination. It is commonly performed after an abnormal screening result to look for precancerous or cancerous changes.

Cervical Cancer

Cancer arising in the cervix, most often after persistent infection with a high-risk human papillomavirus type. Early disease may cause no symptoms; later signs include unusual bleeding, discharge, or pelvic pain.

Cervical Cancer Screening and Prevention

Prevention and early detection of cervical cancer through human papillomavirus (HPV) vaccination and screening for cervical precancer or cancer using cervical cytology, primary high-risk HPV testing, or both.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Cancer Screening

Cervical Cap

A flexible contraceptive barrier placed over the cervix to keep sperm from entering the uterus. It is used with spermicide and must remain in place for the recommended time after sex.

Cervical Carcinoma

A malignant tumor of the uterine cervix, most commonly associated with persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection.

Cervical Cerclage

A procedure that places a strong stitch around the cervix during pregnancy to help keep it closed when early opening raises the risk of pregnancy loss or premature birth. It may be placed through the vagina or abdomen.

Cervical Change

An alteration in the uterine cervix. In labor, it usually means cervical effacement (thinning and shortening) or dilation (opening); the phrase alone does not name a specific cervical lesion or abnormal cell change.

Cervical Dilatation

Opening of the cervix during labor, measured from closed to about 10 centimeters. The cervix also becomes thinner and shorter, allowing the baby's head to pass into the birth canal.

Cervical Dilation

The opening of the cervical canal during labor, progressing from closed to about 10 centimeters. It occurs with thinning and shortening of the cervix and is needed for vaginal birth.

Cervical Disc Herniation

A neck disc bulges or tears and presses on a nearby nerve root or the spinal cord. It may cause neck

pain, arm pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness.

Cervical Discitis

Infection or inflammation of a disc between the bones of the neck. It often causes persistent neck pain and stiffness and may also affect nearby bone.

Cervical Dislocation

Abnormal displacement of one cervical vertebra relative to another, usually from trauma, that can destabilize the neck and injure the spinal cord.

Cervical Dysplasia

See *Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Cervical Dystocia

Failure of the uterine cervix to dilate normally during labor, which can delay or prevent vaginal delivery.

Cervical Dystonia

Involuntary tightening of neck muscles that pulls the head into an unusual position. It may cause neck pain, twisting, jerky movements, or tremor.

Alternate Names:
Spasmodic Torticollis

Cervical Ectropion

A common condition in which cells normally lining the cervical canal extend onto the outer cervix. It may cause increased discharge or bleeding after sex, but it is usually benign and is not the same as cervical cancer.

Cervical Facet Joint Syndrome

Neck pain thought to come from the small joints between the neck bones. This name describes a possible source of pain; it does not by itself prove which joint is causing it.

Cervical Effacement

Thinning and shortening of the cervix during labor, measured from 0% to 100%. Complete effacement leaves the cervix very thin and usually occurs with opening of the cervix.

Cervical Endometriosis

Endometrial-like tissue in or on the cervix that may cause bleeding after sex, pelvic pain, or an abnormal cervical lesion.

Cervical Exam In Labor

A vaginal examination during labor that checks how open and thin the cervix is and how low and positioned the baby's head is. Repeated examinations help assess progress, but are limited when infection or bleeding is a concern.

Cervical Ganglion

A cluster of nerve-cell bodies in the sympathetic chain of the neck that relays autonomic signals to the head, neck, and upper chest.

Cervical Incompetence

Older term; see *Cervical Insufficiency*.

Cervical Insufficiency

Painless cervical shortening or dilation in the second trimester that can lead to pregnancy loss or preterm birth, often with no or only mild contractions.

Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Biopsy-confirmed abnormal changes in the surface squamous cells of the cervix, usually associated with persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection. CIN is graded from 1 to 3 by how abnormal the cells look and how much tissue is affected. CIN is not cancer; many low-grade changes clear, while high-grade changes have a greater chance of becoming cancer if not monitored or treated.

Alternate Names:
CIN

Cervical Length Screening

Ultrasound measurement of the cervix, usually through the vagina, to estimate the risk of premature birth. A shorter cervix can increase risk, but interpretation depends on gestational age, pregnancy history, symptoms, and the measurement method.

Cervical Lymphadenopathy

One or more enlarged or otherwise abnormal lymph nodes in the neck. It often occurs with an infection, but can also result from immune disease or cancer.

Cervical Lymphadenitis

Infection or inflammation of one or more lymph nodes in the neck. The nodes may become swollen and painful, often during or after an infection of the throat, ear, teeth, or skin.

Cervical MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the cervical spine that uses a magnetic field and radio waves to produce detailed images of the neck vertebrae, discs, spinal cord, nerves, and surrounding soft tissues.

Cervical Mucus

Fluid made by glands in the cervix. It becomes thinner and more slippery around ovulation, which can help sperm move, and thicker at other times. During pregnancy, it helps form a protective plug in the cervical canal.

Cervical Muscle Strain

An overstretch or small tear in a neck muscle, often after sudden movement, overuse, or holding the neck in one position for a long time. It can cause pain, tenderness, and stiffness.

Cervical Myelopathy

Dysfunction of the spinal cord caused by compression in the cervical spine, often producing hand clumsiness, gait disturbance, weakness, sensory changes, or abnormal reflexes.

Cervical Osteoarthritis

Alternate name; see *Cervical Spondylosis*.

Cervical Osteomyelitis

Infection of one or more bones in the neck. It may cause persistent neck pain, tenderness, fever, or weakness and needs prompt medical assessment.

Cervical Pain

Alternate name; see *Neck Pain*.

Cervical Plexus

A network of nerves in the neck that carries sensation from the neck and part of the head and helps control some neck muscles and the diaphragm.

Cervical Polyp

A benign, finger-like growth originating from the mucosal lining of the cervix, most commonly from the endocervical canal. Cervical polyps are soft, reddish, and rich in microscopic blood vessels. While many cause no symptoms and are discovered during routine pelvic examinations, they can cause abnormal vaginal bleeding, postcoital spotting, or increased watery discharge; malignant transformation is rare.

Cervical Polyps

Plural form; see *Cervical Polyp*.

Cervical Pregnancy

A rare ectopic pregnancy implanted in the endocervical canal below the internal opening of the cervix. It may present with painless vaginal bleeding after a missed period; the vascular implantation can cause severe hemorrhage. On ultrasound, the gestational sac lies below the internal opening.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Ectopic Pregnancy

Cervical Radiculopathy

Irritation or compression of a nerve leaving the neck, often from a disc problem or arthritis. It can cause neck pain spreading into the arm, with tingling, numbness, or weakness.

Cervical Rib

An extra rib growing from a neck vertebra, usually the lowest one. It often causes no symptoms but can narrow the space for nerves or blood vessels and produce arm pain, numbness, or swelling.

Cervical Rib Syndrome

Pressure on nerves or blood vessels in the space

between the neck and arm, caused by an extra rib or nearby tight tissue. It may cause arm pain, tingling, weakness, swelling, or color change. See also *Thoracic Outlet Syndrome*.

Cervical Ripening

Softening, thinning, and early opening of the cervix before or during labor. It may occur naturally or be induced with medicines or mechanical methods when labor needs to be started; the method depends on cervical findings, pregnancy factors, and uterine-scar history.

Cervical Ripening Agents

Medicines or mechanical devices used to soften and prepare the cervix before labor induction. Options include prostaglandins and cervical balloons; selection and dosing depend on the cervix, pregnancy, contraindications, and local obstetric protocol.

Cervical Screening

Testing used to detect high-risk human papillomavirus infection and precancerous or cancerous changes of the cervix. The method and interval depend on age, prior results, vaccination, immune status, and local guidelines.

Cervical Spine

The seven bones in the neck, numbered C1 through C7. They support the head, protect the upper spinal cord, allow neck movement, and contain openings for important blood vessels.

Cervical Spine CT Scan

Computed tomography of the cervical spine that uses x-rays and computer reconstruction to show the bones and alignment of the neck; it is particularly useful for detecting fractures and other bony abnormalities.

Cervical Spine Fracture

A break in one or more of the seven bones in the neck, usually from a fall, crash, or other injury. It can damage the spinal cord, so suspected fractures need urgent medical assessment.

Cervical Spine Instability

Abnormal movement between the bones of the neck because of injury, worn joints, or disease. It can cause pain or, if severe, press on or injure the spinal cord.

Cervical Spinal Cord Injury

Damage to the spinal cord in the neck, often from a fracture or other injury. It can cause weakness or paralysis, loss of feeling, or problems controlling breathing, the bladder, or the bowel.

Cervical Spinal Stenosis

Narrowing of the space in the neck bones that holds the spinal cord and nerves. It may cause neck pain, numbness, weakness, or trouble walking; some people have no symptoms.

Cervical Spine Involvement in Rheumatoid Arthritis

Rheumatoid arthritis can inflame joints near the top of the neck, especially the joint between the first two neck bones. This may make the bones unstable or press on the spinal cord, causing pain, weakness, numbness, or trouble walking.

Cervical Spine Pain

Alternate name; see *Neck Pain*.

Cervical Spine Trauma

An injury to the neck bones, discs, ligaments, spinal cord, or exiting nerves. It may cause pain, weakness, numbness, or paralysis; severe injury can destabilize the spine or damage the spinal cord.

Cervical Spondyloarthropathy

Wear or inflammation affecting the joints and discs of the neck. It may cause neck stiffness and pain, or press on nerves or the spinal cord, producing arm symptoms, weakness, or walking problems.

Cervical Spondylosis

Age-related wear of the neck, including changes in discs, bones, joints, and ligaments. It may cause neck pain and stiffness and, if nerves or the spinal

cord are compressed, limb symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Degenerative Cervical Spine Disease

Cervical Spondylotic Myelopathy

Pressure on the spinal cord in the neck caused by age-related changes in the bones and discs. It can cause hand clumsiness, weakness, numbness, or problems with balance and walking.

Alternate Names:
CSM

Cervical Squamous Cell Carcinoma

A cancer that begins in the flat surface cells of the cervix, most often after persistent infection with a high-risk human papillomavirus type. It may cause unusual bleeding or discharge, but early disease may have no symptoms.

Cervical Squamous Intraepithelial Lesion

Alternate name; see *Cervical Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Cervical Stenosis

Narrowing or complete closure of the passage through the cervix, the lower part of the uterus. It may be present from birth or develop after menopause, cervical surgery, radiation, endometrial procedures, or cervical or uterine cancer. It often causes no symptoms, but may cause painful or absent periods, abnormal bleeding, trapped blood or pus in the uterus, or rarely infertility. This term refers to the cervix; narrowing of the spinal canal is called cervical spinal stenosis.

Cervical Strain (Whiplash)

Injury to the neck muscles, ligaments, and other soft tissues caused by rapid flexion and extension, commonly during a motor-vehicle collision. Neck pain, stiffness, headache, and shoulder or arm symptoms may occur.

Cervical Vertebrae

The seven bones of the neck, numbered C1 through C7. They support the head, protect the upper spinal cord, and allow neck movement; openings in several of them carry the vertebral arteries.

Cervicitis

Inflammation of the cervix, commonly caused by a sexually transmitted infection, changes in normal vaginal bacteria, chemical irritation, or allergy. It may cause discharge, bleeding after sex, or pelvic discomfort, but can be symptomless.

Cervicogenic Headache

Head pain caused by a problem in the neck, such as a joint, disc, muscle, or nerve disorder. Pain often starts in the neck and spreads to one side of the head and may worsen with neck movement.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Headache; Neck-Related Headache

Cervix

The lower part of the uterus that opens into the vagina. It lets menstrual blood leave the uterus, allows sperm to enter, produces cervical mucus, and widens during childbirth.

Cervix Carcinoma

Cancer arising from the cervix, most often related to persistent high-risk human papillomavirus infection; screening and HPV vaccination reduce risk, and treatment depends on stage.

Cervix Cryosurgery

Freezing abnormal surface cells of the cervix with a very cold probe. It may treat selected precancerous changes after appropriate testing; watery discharge and cramping are common temporarily.

Cervix Disease

Any disorder affecting the lower part of the uterus, including infection, polyps, precancer, cancer, scarring, or pregnancy-related changes. Symptoms and treatment depend on the specific condition.

Cervix Neoplasm

A benign, precancerous, or malignant growth of the cervix; evaluation may include pelvic examination,

HPV testing, cytology, colposcopy, and biopsy.

Cervix Uteri

The cervix uteri is the lower portion of the uterus that projects into the vagina and forms the passage between the uterus and birth canal.

Cesarean Delivery

Alternate name; see *Cesarean Section*.

Cesarean Section

Delivery of a baby through cuts in the abdomen and uterus. It may be planned or done urgently when vaginal birth is unsafe for the pregnant person or baby. The operation is usually done with spinal or epidural medicine so the person is awake but does not feel pain.

Alternate Names:
Caesarean Section; Caesarean Delivery; LSCS

Cesium

A chemical element whose radioactive isotope cesium-137 can cause serious external or internal radiation injury after contamination or exposure.

Cessation of Menstruation

Cessation of menstrual periods, called amenorrhea; it is a normal part of menopause but may also result from pregnancy, illness, endocrine disorders, medications, stress, excessive exercise, or inadequate nutrition.

Cestoda

The tapeworm class of flatworms; human infection follows ingestion of eggs or larval tissue and can cause intestinal disease or tissue cysts.

Cestode

A cestode is a tapeworm, a segmented parasitic flatworm that can infect humans or animals through contaminated food, water, or intermediate hosts.

Cestodiasis

Infection or infestation caused by cestodes, commonly called tapeworms. Disease may involve the intestine or tissues, depending on the species and life-cycle stage.

Alternate Names:
Tapeworm Infection; Cestode Infection

Cetirizine

A second-generation H1 antihistamine used for allergic rhinitis and urticaria; it is less sedating than older antihistamines but can still cause drowsiness.

Cetrimide

An antiseptic and detergent used in some skin preparations and laboratories. It reduces microorganisms by disrupting cell membranes, but concentrated or swallowed amounts can irritate or burn tissues.

Cetrorelix

A hormone-blocking medicine used during assisted reproduction to prevent premature ovulation. It temporarily blocks gonadotropin-releasing hormone receptors; injection-site reactions, headache, nausea, or allergy may occur.

Cetuximab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks the epidermal growth factor receptor. It is used for selected colorectal, head-and-neck, and other cancers and commonly causes acne-like rash.

Cevimeline

A muscarinic receptor agonist used to stimulate salivary secretion and relieve dry mouth, especially in selected patients with Sjögren syndrome.

Cevimeline Hydrochloride

A medicine that stimulates muscarinic receptors to increase saliva. It is used mainly for dry mouth in Sjögren syndrome and can cause sweating, nausea, or blurred vision.

CF

Alternate name; see *Cystic Fibrosis*.

CF (Cystic Fibrosis)

Abbreviation for cystic fibrosis, an inherited disor-

der caused by CFTR variants that produce thick secretions, chronic lung infection, pancreatic insufficiency, infertility in many males, and other organ complications.

C Fiber

A thin nerve fiber that carries slow, aching pain, warmth, and itch from the skin and other tissues to the spinal cord and brain.

CFS

Chronic fatigue syndrome, a condition involving substantial persistent fatigue with post-exertional worsening and associated symptoms that are not explained by another disorder.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Fatigue Syndrome; Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome

CFS (Chronic Fatigue Syndrome)

Abbreviation for myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome, a complex illness involving substantial reduction in activity, post-exertional malaise, unrefreshing sleep, and often cognitive impairment or orthostatic intolerance.

CFTR Modulator Therapy

Medicines that improve the amount or function of defective CFTR protein in people with cystic fibrosis. The appropriate combination depends on the person's CFTR variants; treatment can improve breathing, nutrition, and salt-water balance.

CHA2DS2-VASc Score

A score estimating stroke risk in a person with atrial fibrillation. It considers heart failure, high blood pressure, age, diabetes, previous stroke, blood-vessel disease, and sex; the result helps clinicians decide whether a blood thinner may offer more benefit than harm.

Alternate Names:
CHA2DS2-VASc; Atrial Fibrillation Stroke Risk Score

Chaddock Reflex

Alternate name; see *Chaddock Sign*.

Chaddock Sign

An upward movement of the big toe when the skin along the outer foot is stroked. It can be a sign of damage to nerve pathways in the brain or spinal cord that control movement.

Alternate Names:
Chaddock's Sign

Chadwick Sign

A bluish-purplish discoloration of the cervix, vagina, and vulval mucosa caused by local venous engorgement and heightened vascularity in early pregnancy, typically observable by speculum examination around 6 to 8 weeks of gestation.

Alternate Names:
Chadwick's Sign; Jacquemier Sign

Chafing

Skin irritation caused by repeated friction, moisture, heat, or tight clothing, producing redness, burning, tenderness, and sometimes erosions in opposing or rubbing areas.

Chagas Cardiomyopathy

The chronic, progressive inflammatory and fibrosing cardiac disease resulting from long-standing infection with the protozoan parasite Trypanosoma cruzi (Chagas disease), emerging 10 to 30 years after primary infection in up to 30% of chronically infected individuals. It is characterized by biventricular enlargement, apical left ventricular aneurysms, conduction system disease (notably right bundle branch block and left anterior fascicular block), malignant ventricular tachyarrhythmias, heart failure, and systemic thromboembolism.

Alternate Names:
Chagasic Cardiomyopathy; Chronic Chagasic Cardiomyopathy; Chagas Heart Disease; Trypanosoma Cruzi Cardiomyopathy

Chagas Disease

An infection caused by the protozoan *Trypanosoma*

cruzi. In endemic regions, it is usually transmitted when feces of infected triatomine ("kissing") bugs contaminate a bite wound or mucous membrane. Transmission can also occur congenitally, through transfusion or transplantation, or from contaminated food. Acute disease is often mild or asymptomatic; chronic infection can cause cardiomyopathy, arrhythmias, or enlargement of the esophagus or colon.

Alternate Names:
American Trypanosomiasis; Trypanosoma cruzi Infection

Chagasic Megacolon

A severe gastrointestinal complication of chronic Chagas disease (Trypanosoma cruzi infection) caused by parasite-induced destruction of intramural autonomic ganglia in the myenteric (Auerbach) plexus of the large intestine. The resulting denervation produces loss of coordinated peristalsis, progressive organ dilatation, and muscular hypertrophy predominantly affecting the sigmoid colon and rectum, clinically manifesting with severe intractable constipation, abdominal distention, fecaloma impaction, and risk of sigmoid volvulus.

Alternate Names:
Mega-Megacolon in Chagas Disease; Chagas Megacolon

Chagoma

A red, swollen lump where the parasite causing Chagas disease enters the body. It may be painful and accompanied by swollen nearby lymph nodes during the early stage of infection.

Chain Of Custody

A dated record showing who collected, stored, transferred, tested, and finally disposed of an item or specimen. It helps prove that medical, forensic, or laboratory evidence was identified correctly and was not altered or mixed up.

Chain-Termination Codon

A codon that signals the end of protein translation; the three standard stop codons are UAA, UAG, and UGA in messenger RNA.

Chalazion

A usually painless, firm eyelid lump caused by blockage and inflammation of a meibomian oil gland.

Challenge Agent

A substance, organism, allergen, or physiologic stimulus deliberately administered in a controlled test to provoke and measure a response.

Challenge Testing

A controlled exposure to a suspected trigger, such as a food or medication, to assess whether it produces a reproducible reaction.

Alternate Names:
Provocation Testing; Challenge Test

Chamberlain Procedure

An anterior mediastinotomy surgical technique involving an incision through the second or third left anterior intercostal space with resection of cartilage, designed to biopsy anterior mediastinal masses or aortopulmonary window lymph nodes that are inaccessible via cervical mediastinoscopy.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Mediastinotomy

Chamomile Extract

An extract of chamomile flowers used in traditional and complementary products; allergic reactions and medicine interactions are possible, while evidence varies by indication.

Chanarin-Dorfman Disease

A rare inherited lipid-storage disorder, usually caused by changes in the *ABHD5* gene, in which triglycerides accumulate in skin, liver, muscle, blood cells, and other tissues. It commonly causes congenital ichthyosis and may also cause liver disease, cataracts, hearing loss, muscle weakness, or developmental problems.

Alternate Names:
Chanarin-Dorfman Syndrome; Dorfman-Chanarin Disease; Neutral Lipid Storage Disease With Ichthyosis

Chance Fracture

A horizontal flexion-distraction injury of the thoracolumbar spine involving a transverse fracture line through the vertebral body, pedicles, laminae, and spinous process. Classically associated with lap-type seatbelt restraint deceleration injuries in motor vehicle collisions, it is frequently accompanied by blunt intra-abdominal organ trauma.

Alternate Names:
Seatbelt Fracture; Flexion-Distraction Spine Fracture

Chancre

The usually painless, firm ulcer that forms at the entry site of primary syphilis. It is commonly single, has a clean base, and may be accompanied by enlarged nearby lymph nodes; it can heal without treatment while the infection persists.

Alternate Names:
Syphilitic Chancre

Chancroid

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Haemophilus ducreyi*, producing one or more painful, ragged genital ulcers with a purulent base and tender, sometimes suppurative groin lymph nodes. Clinical diagnosis requires excluding syphilis and genital herpes; antibiotic treatment and partner evaluation are important.

Chandelier Sign

Marked pain elicited by moving the cervix during a pelvic examination, also called cervical motion tenderness. It can support suspicion of pelvic inflammatory disease in the appropriate clinical context, but is nonspecific and may occur with other pelvic conditions.

Chandipura Virus Infection

An acute, fulminant pediatric encephalitis caused by Chandipura virus, a vesiculovirus belonging to the family Rhabdoviridae and transmitted by phlebotomine sandflies (Phlebotomus papatasi). Predominantly affecting children under 15 years of age in central and western India, it is characterized by the rapid onset of high fever, vomiting, and altered sensorium, progressing within 24 to 48 hours to generalized convulsions, coma, and respiratory failure, carrying an exceptionally high case-fatality rate.

Alternate Names:
Chandipura Encephalitis; Chandipura Viral Encephalitis

Change in Bowel Habits

A new change in stool frequency, consistency, caliber, or pattern, including persistent diarrhea, constipation, or alternating bowel habits. Associated bleeding, weight loss, anemia, or severe pain can indicate underlying disease.

Channelopathy

A disorder caused by abnormal proteins that control movement of charged particles through cell membranes. It can affect nerves, muscles, or the heart and may cause seizures, weakness, or abnormal rhythms.

Channelrhodopsin

A microbial light-gated ion-channel protein, originally identified in algae, that conducts ions across a cell membrane when illuminated. Different types conduct cations or anions; in optogenetics, they are used to change the electrical activity of genetically targeted cells with light.

Chaplain

A trained spiritual-care professional who supports patients and families with religious, existential, emotional, or ethical concerns in healthcare settings.

Chapped Hands

Dry, cracked, inflamed skin of the hands caused by irritants, cold, low humidity, frequent washing, eczema, or allergy; fissures can become painful or infected.

Chapped Lips

Dry, scaling, fissured lips caused by weather, licking, dehydration, irritants, medicines, or cheilitis; persistent lesions may be associated with infection or another disorder.

Charcoal

A black carbon-rich material made by heating organic matter with little oxygen. In medicine, specially prepared charcoal may be given in selected poisonings to reduce absorption of some substances, but it is not useful for every poisoning.

Charcot Arthropathy

Progressive joint damage caused by loss of protective sensation, so repeated injuries go unnoticed. The joint may become warm, swollen, unstable, and deformed, especially in people with diabetic nerve damage.

Charcot-Bouchard Aneurysm

A proposed microaneurysmal dilation of a small penetrating cerebral artery associated with chronic hypertension. Hypertensive small-vessel arteriopathy is an established cause of deep brain hemorrhage; the frequency and causal role of discrete Charcot-Bouchard aneurysms remain debated.

Charcot Foot

Progressive bone and joint damage in the foot or ankle associated with peripheral neuropathy and loss of protective sensation. Repeated, often unnoticed injury can cause fractures, instability, and deformity. A warm, red, swollen foot can indicate active Charcot neuroarthropathy.

Alternate Names:
Charcot's Foot

Charcot Joint

Severe destruction of a joint caused by loss of pain and position sensation. Repeated unnoticed injury can fragment bone, loosen or dislocate the joint, and produce major deformity.

Charcot-Leyden Crystals

Slender, microscopic hexagonal bipyramidal crystals composed of eosinophil lysophospholipase (galectin-10) protein. They are found in sputum, stool, tissues, and bodily fluids in conditions characterized by eosinophilic inflammation, notably bronchial asthma, allergic rhinitis, and invasive parasitic infestations.

Alternate Names:
Charcot-Leyden Crystal; Galectin-10 Crystals

Charcot-Marie-Tooth Disease

A group of inherited peripheral-nerve disorders that damage nerves supplying the feet, legs, hands, and arms. Symptoms usually include gradually worsening weakness, muscle wasting, numbness, foot deformity, and difficulty walking. It is genetically heterogeneous and may follow autosomal dominant, autosomal recessive, or X-linked inheritance.

Alternate Names:
CMT; Hereditary Motor and Sensory Neuropathy (HMSN)

Charcot's Joints

Charcot's joints are severely damaged, unstable joints caused by loss of protective sensation, classically in diabetic neuropathy or other neurologic disease.

Charcot's Triad

Charcot's triad is fever, jaundice, and right-upper-quadrant pain, a classic but incomplete clinical pattern of acute ascending cholangitis.

Charcot Triad

The combination of fever, pain in the upper-right abdomen, and jaundice, traditionally associated with acute infection of blocked bile ducts. This pattern is important but may be absent even in serious disease.

Charcot Triad of Cholangitis

The combination of fever, pain in the upper-right abdomen, and jaundice. It is a classic pattern of infection in blocked bile ducts, but many people with serious infection do not have all three signs.

Charcot-Wilbrand Syndrome

A rare neuropsychiatric syndrome after brain injury characterized by loss of visual imagery and visual dreaming, sometimes with difficulty recognizing or interpreting visual information.

Chargaff Rule

The observation that double-stranded DNA contains approximately equal amounts of adenine and thymine and of guanine and cytosine, reflecting complementary base pairing.

CHARGE Syndrome

A genetic condition, usually involving a new change in the CHD7 gene, that can affect the eyes, ears, heart, breathing passages, growth, development, and reproductive system. Features vary widely.

Charles Bonnet Syndrome

Visual hallucinations occurring in a person with significant vision loss who otherwise understands that the images are not real. The images may be simple patterns or detailed scenes; similar hallucinations can have other causes.

Charley Horse

A sudden painful muscle cramp, commonly in the calf or thigh. It may follow exercise, dehydration, prolonged positioning, nerve problems, or certain medicines and usually lasts from seconds to minutes.

Char Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder, usually caused by variants in *TFAP2B*, characterized by distinctive facial features, a heart defect such as patent ductus arteriosus, and abnormalities of the fifth fingers or toes.

Chasing The Dragon

Inhalation of vapor produced by heating heroin, a method of drug use that can cause dependence, overdose, toxic exposures, and neurological injury.

Chaulmoogra Oil

Chaulmoogra oil is a historical plant oil once used to treat leprosy and some skin diseases; it has largely been replaced by effective antimicrobial therapy.

CHD

Alternate index label; see *Congenital Heart Disease*.

Checkpoint Inhibitor

A class of monoclonal antibody immunotherapies that block negative inhibitory regulators of T-cell activation (such as PD-1, PD-L1, or CTLA-4), thereby relieving immune suppression and unleashing antitumor cytotoxic T-lymphocyte responses.

Alternate Names:
Immune Checkpoint Inhibitor; ICI

Checkpoints

Regulatory signals that help prevent immune cells from attacking healthy tissues. Some cancers use checkpoint pathways to evade immunity; checkpoint-inhibitor medicines block selected signals to restore antitumor immune activity.

Chediak-Higashi Syndrome

A rare inherited immune disorder caused by changes in both copies of the LYST gene. It can cause unusually light or silvery hair, repeated infections, easy bruising, nerve problems, and a severe inflammatory crisis.

Cheek

The facial region forming the side wall of the mouth, containing skin, muscle, fat, salivary structures, nerves, and blood vessels.

Cheilectropion

An eversion deformity of the lip, usually involving the lower lip. It may result from scarring, congenital malformation, or loss of tissue support.

Cheilitis

Inflammation of one or both lips that can cause dryness, peeling, cracks, swelling, pain, or sores. Causes include irritation, allergy, infection, low nutrient levels, sun exposure, or skin disease.

Cheilitis Glandularis

A rare inflammatory disorder of minor salivary glands in the lips, usually the lower lip, causing enlarged gland openings, swelling, mucus or saliva discharge, and sometimes eversion of the lip. Persistent lesions need biopsy or specialist assessment

because chronic inflammation can mimic or coexist with neoplasia.

Cheilitis Granulomatosa

Persistent swelling of one or both lips caused by granulomatous inflammation. It may occur alone or as part of Melkersson–Rosenthal syndrome or Crohn disease, which may also involve recurrent swelling, facial palsy, or a fissured tongue.

Cheilodynia

Pain of the lips, which may result from inflammation, infection, trauma, allergy, dryness, nerve pain, or another oral or dermatologic disorder.

Cheilognathopalatoschisis

A birth defect in which the upper lip, the gum-bearing part of the jaw, and the roof of the mouth do not join completely before birth. It can interfere with feeding, speech, hearing, and tooth development.

Cheilognathoschisis

A congenital cleft of the lip and alveolar part of the upper jaw, with or without associated palatal involvement.

Cheiloplasty

Plastic or reconstructive surgery of the lip, performed to repair congenital clefting, trauma, tumors, scars, or other deformity.

Cheiloschisis

Cleft lip, a congenital fissure of the upper lip caused by incomplete fusion of facial processes during embryonic development. It may occur alone or with cleft palate.

Cheilosis

A disorder of the lips characterized by dryness, scaling, fissuring, or inflammation. Causes include irritation, nutritional deficiency, infection, and systemic disease.

Cheiromegaly

Abnormal enlargement of one or both hands, classically associated with excess growth hormone but also possible with local overgrowth or other disorders.

Cheiropompholyx

A hand-limited form of dyshidrotic eczema causing recurrent, intensely itchy, small fluid-filled blisters on the palms or sides of the fingers. The blisters may be followed by peeling or painful cracks.

Chelating Agent

A substance or medication that binds tightly to heavy metals or minerals in the bloodstream and tissues, forming a stable chemical complex that the body can safely excrete through urine or stool. In medicine, these agents are used to remove toxic levels of metals such as lead, mercury, arsenic, or excess copper.

Chelating Agents

Plural form; see *Chelating Agent*.

Chelation

The formation of a stable complex between a metal ion and a molecule with multiple binding sites. In medicine, chelation can be used under supervision to bind and promote elimination of selected toxic metals.

Chelation Study

A test that uses a metal-binding substance and imaging or blood measurements to assess how the body handles a mineral or to locate abnormal deposits. The exact method depends on the clinical question.

Chelation Therapy

Treatment using a medicine that binds a specific harmful or excess metal so the body can remove it in urine or stool. It is used only for selected poisonings or disorders because it can harm the kidneys or alter essential minerals.

Chemexfoliation

Application of a chemical solution to remove controlled layers of skin, improving selected scars, pigmentation, wrinkles, or superficial lesions.

Chemical

A substance defined by its molecular composition and properties; medical effects depend on dose, route, exposure duration, metabolism, and biological target.

Chemical Ablation

Destruction of tissue by applying or injecting a chemical. Examples include chemical cautery of small lesions and sclerotherapy, in which a chemical irritates a vein so it closes.

Chemical Burn

Acute destructive tissue injury resulting from exposure to caustic acidic, alkaline, or organic chemical agents. Strong acids (e.g., sulfuric, hydrochloric, nitric) produce coagulative necrosis with protein precipitation, forming a protective surface eschar that tends to limit deep penetration. Strong alkalis (e.g., sodium hydroxide, lye, lime, ammonia) cause saponification of cellular fatty acids and liquefactive necrosis, enabling rapid, deep, and progressive tissue destruction. Initial emergency management mandates immediate, voluminous water irrigation for a minimum of 15–30 minutes (with exceptions for lime or elemental sodium), removal of contaminated clothing, and agent-specific antidotal therapy (e.g., topical calcium gluconate for hydrofluoric acid burns).

Chemical Burn Or Reaction

Tissue injury caused by contact with a corrosive or irritating chemical, commonly affecting the skin or eyes; severity depends on the substance, concentration, contact time, and tissue involved.

Chemical Burns

Plural form; see *Chemical Burn*.

Chemical Carcinogenesis

Development of cancer after exposure to chemicals that cause DNA damage, abnormal cell signaling, chronic tissue injury, or altered gene regulation.

Chemical Cleavage

Breaking a chemical bond with a reagent, used in laboratory analysis, molecular biology, synthesis, or controlled degradation of a larger molecule.

Chemical Cofactor

A nonprotein chemical helper required for an enzyme or biologic reaction, such as a metal ion, vitamin-derived coenzyme, or other small molecule.

Chemical Eye Injury

Damage to the eye from an acidic or alkaline substance. Alkaline chemicals can continue penetrating tissue and cause progressive damage.

Chemical Fractionation

Separation of a mixture into fractions according to chemical or physical properties such as solubility, charge, size, or binding affinity.

Chemical Impurity

An unintended chemical present in a medicine, specimen, or material, potentially affecting safety, stability, measurement accuracy, or biologic activity.

Chemical Injury

Tissue damage caused by contact with a corrosive or irritating chemical. Acids and alkalis can destroy tissue differently; effects depend on concentration, exposure time, and affected body area.

Chemical Peel

A dermatologic skin-resurfacing procedure involving the controlled topical application of chemical exfoliating agents to induce epidermal and dermal necrosis followed by re-epithelialization and neocollagenesis. Stratified by histologic depth of injury: superficial peels (α-hydroxy glycolic/lactic acids, β-hydroxy salicylic acid, Jessner solution) penetrate the epidermis to treat superficial dyschromia and acne; medium-depth peels (trichloroacetic acid [TCA] 35–50%) penetrate the papillary dermis

to target actinic keratoses and moderate rhytids; and deep peels (Baker-Gordon phenol formulation) penetrate the reticular dermis for severe photoaging, requiring cardiac monitoring due to systemic phenol cardiotoxicity.

Chemical Peels

Plural form; see *Chemical Peel*.

Chemical Pleurodesis

A therapeutic procedure in which a sclerosing chemical agent (such as sterile talc slurry, doxycycline, or bleomycin) is instilled into the pleural space via a chest tube to induce intense parietal and visceral pleural inflammation, obliterating the pleural cavity to prevent recurrent pneumothorax or malignant pleural effusion.

Chemical Pneumonitis

Lung inflammation and injury after inhaling or breathing in irritating chemicals, stomach contents, fuels, or other toxic substances. It may cause cough, shortness of breath, wheezing, low oxygen, and chest imaging changes.

Chemistry

The study of substances, their composition, properties, reactions, and transformations, forming the basis of biochemistry, pharmacology, toxicology, and laboratory medicine.

Chemo

Informal shorthand for chemotherapy, treatment using drugs that destroy cancer cells, inhibit their growth, or suppress abnormal immune cells.

Chemoattractant

A chemical signal that guides cells, especially immune cells, toward its source. Such signals help direct cells to areas of infection, inflammation, tissue repair, or normal development.

Chemo Brain

Problems with memory, concentration, word-finding, or mental processing that may occur during or after cancer treatment. Symptoms can affect work and daily activities and may have several contributing causes.

Chemodectoma

A usually slow-growing tumour arising from specialized hormone-sensing nerve tissue, most often near the carotid artery in the neck. It may cause a neck lump or press on nearby nerves and blood vessels.

Chemoembolization

A treatment that delivers cancer medicine through an artery feeding a tumour and then blocks that artery. It is used mainly for selected liver cancers to concentrate treatment and reduce the tumour's blood supply.

Chemokine

A small signaling protein that directs immune cells to sites of infection, inflammation, or tissue repair. Different chemokines attract different cell types by binding to matching receptors.

Chemokine Receptor

A cell-surface receptor that binds chemokines and directs immune-cell movement; some also serve as entry cofactors for viruses such as HIV.

Chemokinesis

Increased or altered movement of a cell in response to a chemical, without movement specifically toward or away from the chemical source. It differs from chemotaxis, which is directional.

Chemoprevention

The use of a medicine or other chemical substance to lower the chance of cancer developing or returning. It may be considered for selected high-risk people, but benefits, side effects, and evidence differ by cancer and medicine.

Chemoradiation

Treatment that gives chemotherapy and radiation during the same treatment period. The medicine may make cancer cells more sensitive to radiation

and may treat cancer elsewhere, but combined side effects can be greater.

Chemoradiotherapy

Cancer treatment that combines chemotherapy with radiation treatment. The medicines may make cancer cells more sensitive to radiation or treat cells elsewhere, but combined treatment can increase tiredness, nausea, skin changes, and other side effects.

Chemoreceptor

A specialized sensory nerve ending or cell that detects changes in the chemical composition of blood or surrounding fluids. In the body, internal chemoreceptors in the brainstem and major arteries monitor levels of oxygen, carbon dioxide, and acidity (pH) in the blood, automatically signaling the respiratory and cardiovascular centers to adjust breathing rate and heart function.

Chemoreceptor Cell

A sensory cell that detects chemical changes such as oxygen, carbon dioxide, pH, taste molecules, or odorants and converts them into neural or physiologic signals.

Chemoreceptor Reflex

An autonomic homeostatic reflex initiated by peripheral (carotid and aortic bodies) or central (medullary) chemoreceptors in response to hypoxia, hypercapnia, or acidosis, driving increases in minute ventilation, sympathetic vasomotor tone, and blood pressure.

Chemoreceptors

Plural form; see *Chemoreceptor*.

Chemoreceptor Trigger Zone

A brain area that detects vomiting-provoking chemicals in the blood or cerebrospinal fluid and activates brain circuits that produce nausea and vomiting.

Chemoresistance

Reduced response of cancer cells or other target cells to a medicine that previously inhibited or destroyed them. It may be present from the start or develop during treatment.

Chemosensitivity

How strongly cells or a tumor respond to a chemical treatment. A sensitive tumor may shrink or stop growing, but laboratory sensitivity tests do not always predict a person's treatment response.

Chemosensitization

Making cancer cells or microorganisms more vulnerable to treatment by adding an agent that improves delivery, blocks resistance, or increases treatment-related damage.

Chemosis

Swelling of the clear membrane covering the white part of the eye. It may result from allergy, infection, irritation, injury, surgery, or fluid retention and can make the eye look blistered.

Chemosurgery

Chemosurgery uses a chemical agent to destroy selected abnormal tissue, historically including chemical treatment of skin lesions; modern use is specialized.

Chemotactic Factors

Chemical signals that attract or repel cells by forming a concentration gradient. During infection or tissue injury, they help direct immune cells to the affected area.

Chemotaxis

Directed movement of a cell or organism toward or away from a chemical stimulus. It is important in immune-cell recruitment and inflammatory responses.

Chemotherapy

Treatment using medicines to kill cancer cells or slow their growth, often by disrupting cell division or damaging DNA. It may be used alone or with surgery or radiation. Healthy fast-growing cells can

also be affected, causing nausea, hair loss, anemia, or reduced immunity.

Chemotherapy Extravasation

Leakage of an intravenous cancer medicine into tissue around the vein. Some medicines can cause severe pain, blistering, or tissue death; management depends on the medicine and extent of tissue exposure.

Chemotherapy-Induced Nausea and Vomiting

A common and debilitating adverse effect of antineoplastic therapy mediated by central neurokinin-1 (NK1) and peripheral/central serotonin (5-HT3) receptor pathways, categorized as acute, delayed, anticipatory, or breakthrough emesis.

Alternate Names:
CINV

Chemotherapy-Induced Oral Mucositis

Painful inflammation and ulceration of the mouth caused by injury to rapidly dividing oral lining cells during chemotherapy or some cancer treatments. It can impair eating, drinking, and speech and increase infection risk; oral care, pain control, nutrition, and treatment of infection are important.

Chemotherapy-Induced Peripheral Neuropathy

Nerve damage caused by some cancer medicines. It commonly produces tingling, numbness, burning pain, or unusual sensitivity in the hands and feet and may affect balance, movement, or daily activities.

Chemotherapy Regimen

A specific combination of anticancer drugs, dosing schedule, and treatment cycles designed for a particular cancer type and stage. Regimens are standardized by evidence-based protocols and may be modified based on response, toxicity, and patient factors.

Chemotherapy Treatment

Chemotherapy uses medicines that damage or inhibit rapidly dividing cancer cells. It may be given before or after local treatment, for advanced disease, or for symptom control; effects and monitoring depend on the drugs, cancer, treatment goal, and organ function.

Cherry Angioma

A common harmless growth made of small blood vessels, usually a bright-red or purple spot or bump on the trunk or limbs. It may bleed after injury but usually needs no treatment unless the diagnosis is uncertain or removal is wanted.

Alternate Names:
Campbell de Morgan Spot

Cherry Eye

Prolapse of the gland of the third eyelid, producing a rounded red mass at the inner corner of the eye. The term is used especially in veterinary ophthalmology.

Cherry Hemangioma

Alternate name; see *Cherry Angioma*.

Cherry-Red Spot

A bright-red area at the center of the retina surrounded by pale retina. It occurs when the surrounding retina becomes swollen or loses blood flow and may indicate a serious metabolic, vascular, or storage disorder.

Cherubism

A rare inherited condition in which both sides of the jaw enlarge because of overgrowth of bone-removing tissue. It usually begins in childhood and often improves after puberty, but it can affect teeth, chewing, speech, or appearance.

Chest

The thorax, the region between the neck and abdomen containing the heart, lungs, major vessels, and other structures protected by the ribs and sternum.

Chest Cold

Alternate name; see *Acute Bronchitis*.

Chest CT

Computed tomography of the chest using x-rays and computer reconstruction to produce cross-sectional images of the lungs, heart, blood vessels, mediastinum, pleura, and chest wall.

Chest CT Scan

A specialized cross-sectional X-ray examination of the lungs, heart, great vessels, and chest wall; see *Chest CT*.

Chest Infection

An infection of the airways or lung, commonly caused by a virus or bacterium. It may cause cough, mucus, fever, wheezing, chest discomfort, or shortness of breath; severe breathing difficulty, confusion, blue lips, or persistent high fever may indicate severe illness.

Chest MRI

Magnetic resonance imaging of the chest using a magnetic field and radio waves to evaluate soft tissues, blood vessels, heart structures, mediastinum, chest wall, and selected lung or pleural abnormalities.

Chest Pain

Pain, pressure, burning, or discomfort in the chest. Causes include heart, lung, digestive, muscle, bone, or anxiety-related problems. New severe pain, breathlessness, sweating, faintness, or spreading pain requires emergency care.

Alternate Names:
Angina Pectoris; Thoracalgia; Chest Discomfort

Chest Physiotherapy

Techniques that help move mucus out of the lungs, including positioning, gentle percussion, breathing exercises, coughing techniques, and selected breathing devices. It may help some people with bronchiectasis, cystic fibrosis, or recovery after surgery.

Chest Tightness

A sensation of pressure, constriction, or heaviness in the chest that may arise from heart, lung, gastrointestinal, musculoskeletal, or anxiety-related causes.

Chest Tube

A flexible tube inserted into the pleural space to remove air, blood, or fluid and help the lung re-expand.

Chest Tube Insertion

Placement of a flexible tube through the chest wall into the space around a lung to remove air, blood, pus, or fluid and help the lung expand. It is connected to a drainage system and requires monitoring for bleeding, infection, or persistent air leak.

Chest Tube Thoracostomy

Placement of a tube through the chest wall into the space around a lung to drain air, blood, pus, or fluid. It may be needed for a collapsed lung, bleeding, infected fluid, or certain problems after chest or heart surgery.

Chest Wall

The layers of skin, muscle, ribs, breastbone, spine, and supporting tissues that surround the chest. They protect the heart and lungs and move with the breathing muscles to help expand and contract the chest.

Chest Wall Deformity

An abnormal shape of the ribs, breastbone, spine, or surrounding tissues. A sunken or protruding breastbone is often mainly cosmetic, but severe deformity or scoliosis can restrict breathing or affect the heart.

Chest Wall Pain

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.

Chest X-Ray

An imaging test using a small amount of radiation to show the lungs, heart, ribs, and chest structures. It can detect pneumonia, collapsed lung, fluid, some fractures, and changes in heart size.

Chewing

The coordinated use of teeth, jaw muscles, and joints to break food into smaller pieces for swallowing and digestion; pain or missing teeth can interfere.

Chewing Tobacco

Alternate name; see *Smokeless Tobacco*.

Cheyne-Stokes Respiration

A repeating pattern in which breathing gradually becomes deeper and faster, then shallower, followed by a pause. It may occur during sleep with heart failure, stroke, brain disease, or at high altitude.

CHF

Heart failure in which the heart cannot pump or fill well enough for the body's needs. Reduced circulation can cause breathlessness, tiredness, leg swelling, and fluid buildup in the lungs or elsewhere.

CHH

Abbreviation for congenital or central hypogonadotropic hypogonadism, in which deficient hypothalamic or pituitary signaling leads to low sex-hormone production and absent or incomplete puberty. Some forms also cause reduced or absent sense of smell.

Chiari-Frommel Syndrome

Continued milk production and absent menstrual periods after pregnancy, usually caused by persistently high prolactin levels. Evaluation looks for pituitary disorders, medicines, thyroid disease, and other causes.

Chiari I Malformation

A condition in which the lower part of the cerebellum extends through the opening at the skull base. It may cause headaches worsened by straining, neck pain, balance problems, or no symptoms.

Chiari Malformation

A structural abnormality in which part of the cerebellum extends downward through the opening at the base of the skull. Different types vary in severity and may cause headache, balance problems, swallowing difficulty, or no symptoms.

Chickenpox

An acute, highly contagious primary infection with varicella-zoster virus. An itchy generalized rash appears in successive crops as spots, blisters, and crusts, often with fever and malaise; adults, pregnant people, newborns, and immunocompromised people have higher risk of pneumonia or other severe complications.

Chickenpox (Varicella)

A contagious infection caused by varicella-zoster virus, producing an itchy blistering rash, fever, and malaise. Complications include bacterial skin infection, pneumonia, cerebellitis, and severe disease in pregnancy or immunocompromise.

Chicken Soup And Sickness

A supportive-care topic concerning the use of warm fluids and nutrition during illness; chicken soup may ease hydration or congestion but does not replace diagnosis or treatment.

Chief Cell

A cell in the stomach lining that makes pepsinogen, an inactive substance that becomes the protein-digesting enzyme pepsin in stomach acid.

Chigger Bites

Itchy skin reactions caused by larval mites. Small red bumps or blisters often develop where clothing is tight and may itch for days. Washing the skin, avoiding scratching, and itch treatment usually provide relief.

Chiggers

Larval harvest mites whose bite causes intensely itchy grouped red papules or welts; symptoms result from skin irritation, not from the mite burrowing into human tissue.

Chignon

Temporary swelling of a baby's scalp where a vac-

uum device was applied during assisted delivery. It results from the suction and usually disappears within a day or two without treatment.

CHIK

Alternate name; see *Chikungunya*.

Chikungunya

A mosquito-borne viral disease caused by chikungunya virus, usually producing abrupt fever and severe, often symmetric joint pain. Headache, muscle pain, joint swelling, nausea, fatigue, and rash may occur; joint symptoms can persist for months or years.

Alternate Names:
Chikungunya Fever; Chikungunya Virus Disease; CHIKV Infection

Chikungunya Fever

An acute arboviral febrile illness caused by the Chikungunya virus (genus *Alphavirus*) transmitted by *Aedes* mosquitoes, characterized by high fever, maculopapular rash, and severe, often incapacitating bilateral polyarthralgia and polyarthritis that may persist chronically.

Chikungunya Virus

An alphavirus transmitted primarily by infected female Aedes aegypti and Aedes albopictus mosquitoes. Infection can cause abrupt fever, severe polyarthralgia, joint swelling, rash, and prolonged inflammatory joint symptoms.

Chilaiditi Syndrome

The symptomatic clinical presentation of Chilaiditi sign, defined as the anatomical interposition of a loop of colon or small intestine between the superior surface of the liver and the right hemidiaphragm. Manifests with intermittent abdominal pain, constipation, nausea, vomiting, or abdominal distention, occasionally mimicking a perforated hollow viscus with pseudo-pneumoperitoneum on abdominal radiography.

Alternate Names:
Hepatodiaphragmatic Interposition Syndrome

Chilblain

A localized, pruritic, and painful inflammatory cutaneous vascular reaction precipitated by exposure to non-freezing cold and damp temperatures. Pathophysiologically driven by persistent vasoconstriction of superficial dermal arterioles coupled with delayed vasodilatation upon rewarming, leading to vascular leakage, edema, and perivascular lymphocytic infiltration. Clinically manifests as erythematous, violaceous, or purpuric papules, macules, or nodules primarily affecting acral sites (toes, fingers, nose, ears). Usually self-limiting within 1–3 weeks; management focuses on slow rewarming, warm dry protective garments, smoking cessation, and oral calcium channel blockers (nifedipine) for severe or recurrent cases.

Alternate Names:
Chilblains; Pernio

Chilblains

Plural form; see *Chilblain*.

Child Abuse

Physical, sexual, or emotional harm, or serious neglect, inflicted on a child by a caregiver or another person. Warning signs may include unexplained injuries, changing accounts, fear, developmental changes, or unmet basic needs; suspected abuse requires safeguarding action under local law.

Child Adoption

Child adoption is the legal process by which parental rights and caregiving responsibility are transferred to adoptive parents; medical care includes records, consent, and family history.

Childbed Fever

An older name for fever caused by infection after childbirth, miscarriage, or abortion. The infection often affects the uterus and may cause lower abdominal pain, foul-smelling discharge, or worsening illness.

Child Behavior

The observable actions, responses, and conduct of children, influenced by developmental stage, tem-

perament, environment, and neurobiological factors. Behavioral assessment helps identify developmental disorders, emotional difficulties, and parenting needs.

Childbirth

The process of giving birth. Labour usually includes cervical opening, birth of the baby, and delivery of the placenta; timing and the need for medical assistance vary between pregnancies.

Child Development

Progressive physical, cognitive, language, emotional, and social changes from infancy through adolescence, assessed against developmental milestones and individual variation.

Child Health

The physical, developmental, mental, and social well-being of children, including prevention, nutrition, immunization, safety, and treatment of illness.

Child Health Services

Child health services provide preventive care, immunization, growth and developmental monitoring, screening, treatment, and support for children and families.

Childhood

The developmental period between infancy and adolescence, during which physical growth, brain development, learning, and social skills progress.

Childhood Absence Epilepsy

An epilepsy syndrome that usually begins in school-aged children with frequent brief pauses in awareness. During a seizure, the child may stare and stop responding for seconds, then quickly return to normal without confusion.

Childhood ADHD

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder beginning in childhood, with persistent developmentally inappropriate inattention, hyperactivity, or impulsivity that causes impairment across one or more settings.

Childhood Angiosarcoma

A rare malignant tumor arising from blood-vessel or lymphatic-endothelial cells in a child; diagnosis and treatment require specialist pediatric oncology care.

Childhood Apraxia Of Speech

A speech-sound disorder in which a child has difficulty planning and coordinating the movements needed for clear speech.

Childhood Asthma

Asthma beginning during childhood, involving variable airway narrowing and inflammation that cause wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or shortness of breath.

Childhood Cataracts

Cataracts occurring during infancy, childhood, or adolescence. They may be inherited, present at birth, caused by injury or inflammation, or associated with another condition, and can interfere with visual development.

Childhood Cyclic Vomiting

Recurrent stereotyped episodes of intense nausea and vomiting separated by periods of normal health. It is a functional gut-brain disorder diagnosed after other causes are considered and may be associated with migraine.

Childhood Depression

Depressive illness in a child, which may present as persistent sadness, irritability, loss of interest, withdrawal, sleep or appetite change, low energy, poor concentration, or physical complaints. Suicidal thoughts may accompany severe depression.

Childhood Disintegrative Disorder

A historical diagnostic term for marked developmental regression after at least two years of apparently typical development, with loss of language, social, motor, or adaptive skills. It is no longer a separate DSM-5 diagnosis; such presentations are assessed within autism spectrum disorder and for neurologic or other medical causes.

Alternate Names:
CDD; Heller's Syndrome; Heller's Dementia; Disintegrative Psychosis

Childhood Ependymoma

A tumor arising from ependymal cells lining the brain ventricles or spinal canal in children; symptoms depend on location and obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid flow.

Childhood Fibrosarcoma

A malignant tumor of fibroblastic connective tissue in children, usually presenting as a growing mass; treatment depends on location, extent, and tumor biology.

Childhood Ganglioglioma

A usually slow-growing mixed neuronal and glial brain tumor in children or young adults, often presenting with long-standing focal seizures.

Childhood Giant Axonal Neuropathy

The childhood-onset form of giant axonal neuropathy, a rare inherited neurodegenerative disorder causing progressive peripheral neuropathy, ataxia, weakness, developmental or cognitive changes, and characteristic tightly curled hair in many affected people.

Childhood Interstitial Lung Disease

A group of rare lung disorders in infants and children that affect the tissue around the air sacs and may interfere with oxygen exchange. They can cause rapid breathing, cough, low oxygen, poor growth, or limited exercise ability.

Childhood Leiomyosarcoma

A rare malignant tumor of smooth muscle in a child; it may arise in soft tissue or an organ and requires biopsy, staging, and specialist treatment.

Childhood Leukemia

Cancer of blood-forming cells in a child, most often acute lymphoblastic or acute myeloid leukemia; symptoms may include pallor, bruising, fever, bone pain, or recurrent infection.

Childhood Liposarcoma

A rare malignant tumor derived from fat-forming tissue in a child; diagnosis requires imaging and biopsy, and treatment is individualized by a sarcoma team.

Childhood Muscular Dystrophy

A group of inherited disorders causing progressive muscle weakness and wasting beginning in childhood. Different types vary in inheritance, muscles affected, heart and breathing involvement, and rate of progression.

Childhood Obesity

Alternate index label; see *Pediatric Obesity*.

Childhood Osteosarcoma

A malignant bone tumor that commonly develops near the ends of long bones during adolescence; pain, swelling, or a fracture may occur and treatment combines chemotherapy and surgery.

Childhood Rhabdomyosarcoma

A malignant tumor showing skeletal-muscle differentiation, occurring mainly in children and adolescents; it may arise in the head and neck, urinary or reproductive tract, or limbs.

Childhood Schizophrenia

A rare psychotic disorder beginning in childhood, involving disturbances in thinking, perception, behavior, and emotional functioning.

Alternate Names:
Very Early-Onset Schizophrenia (VEOS); Early-Onset Schizophrenia

Childhood Vaccine Hesitancy

A caregiver's reluctance, uncertainty, delay, or refusal regarding one or more vaccines recommended for a child, even when vaccination services are available. It can reflect concerns about vaccines, confidence, perceived need, practical barriers, or other factors, and may vary by vaccine and context.

Child Maltreatment

Abuse or neglect of a child, including physical, sexual, or emotional abuse and failure to provide needed care or supervision. It can harm a child's safety, health, growth, and development.

Alternate Names:
Child Abuse

CHILD Naevus

A congenital skin and limb disorder named for congenital hemidysplasia with ichthyosiform erythroderma and limb defects. It causes one-sided scaly skin changes with asymmetrical limb or skeletal abnormalities and may involve other organs.

Child Neglect

Failure to provide a child with adequate food, shelter, clothing, supervision, education, emotional care, or medical care. It can impair growth, development, safety, and health and requires safeguarding assessment when suspected.

Child Neglect And Emotional Abuse

Failure to provide a child's basic needs or repeated behavior that harms emotional development, safety, or wellbeing; suspected abuse requires safeguarding assessment and appropriate reporting under local law.

Child Physical Abuse

Intentional physical injury or harm inflicted on a child by a caregiver or another person, including hitting, burning, shaking, or fractures. Suspected abuse can involve immediate safety risks.

Child Poisoning

Exposure of a child to a medicine, chemical, plant, or other substance that may cause harm. Symptoms can be delayed or absent initially, depending on the substance and amount.

Child Psychiatry

The medical specialty concerned with assessment and treatment of emotional, behavioral, developmental, and psychiatric disorders in children and adolescents.

Child Psychology

The study of children's cognitive, emotional, social, and behavioral development and the effects of relationships, learning, biology, and environment.

Child-Pugh Classification

A scoring system used to estimate the severity of chronic liver disease. It combines blood bilirubin, albumin, and clotting results with fluid in the abdomen and liver-related confusion; the score supports, but does not replace, individual assessment.

Child-Pugh Score

A score estimating the severity and prognosis of chronic liver disease, especially cirrhosis. It uses bilirubin, albumin, prothrombin time or INR, ascites, and hepatic encephalopathy. It may inform perioperative risk and clinical assessment, but does not by itself determine whether liver transplantation is indicated.

Alternate Names:
Child-Turcotte-Pugh Score; CTP Score

Children

Humans in the developmental period between infancy and adolescence; medical assessment must account for age-specific anatomy, physiology, growth, communication, and consent.

Children And Grief

The emotional and behavioral response of children to death or major loss, which varies by developmental stage and may include sadness, regression, anger, worry, or physical symptoms.

Children's Cancer Centers

Specialized services that coordinate diagnosis, treatment, rehabilitation, psychosocial support, survivorship care, and research for children and adolescents with cancer.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Oncology Centers; Childhood Cancer Clinics

CHILD Syndrome

Congenital hemidysplasia with ichthyosiform nevus and limb defects, a rare disorder usually caused by an *NSDHL* variant. It causes one-sided skin abnormalities with limb, skeletal, and sometimes neurologic or internal-organ differences.

Chill

An episode of shivering accompanied by a subjective sensation of intense cold and cutaneous vasoconstriction. In febrile states, endogenous pyrogens (IL-1, TNF-α, IL-6) act on the preoptic hypothalamic thermoregulatory center to elevate the core temperature set-point, triggering involuntary somatic muscle shivering and peripheral vasoconstriction to elevate body temperature to the new set-point. Severe, uncontrollable shaking chills (rigors) are strongly indicative of systemic bacteremia, pyelonephritis, or sepsis.

Chills

Plural form; see *Chill*.

Chilomastix Mesnili

A usually harmless single-celled organism that may be found in stool. Its presence generally does not cause illness and can indicate exposure to contaminated food or water.

Chimera

An organism or tissue containing genetically distinct cell populations derived from different zygotes or embryos, or a laboratory construct combining genetic material from different sources.

Chimeric Antigen Receptor

A synthetic receptor engineered to recognize a selected target on a cell surface. It is placed into immune cells, especially T cells, to direct them against cancer cells in some cellular immunotherapies.

Chimeric Antigen Receptor T-Cell Therapy

Alternate name; see *CAR T-Cell Therapy*.

Chimerism

The presence in one person of groups of cells with different genetic origins. It may occur naturally, after an organ or stem-cell transplant, or when cells pass between a pregnant person and fetus.

Chin

The lower facial prominence formed mainly by the mandible and overlying soft tissue, contributing to facial contour, speech, chewing, and airway anatomy.

Chin Augmentation

A cosmetic procedure that increases chin projection with an implant, injectable filler, or bone surgery to change facial contour; risks include infection, asymmetry, nerve injury, and implant problems.

Chinese Herbal Medicine

The use of plant, mineral, or animal-derived preparations within traditional Chinese medicine. Products vary in composition and may interact with medicines or contain contaminants, so reliable sourcing and medical guidance are important.

Chinese Restaurant Syndrome

An older, controversial term for short-lived symptoms such as headache, flushing, or palpitations attributed to eating restaurant food; evidence does not show that monosodium glutamate causes these symptoms in most people at usual dietary exposures.

Chionablepsia

Temporary eye pain and blurred vision caused by ultraviolet light reflected from snow or ice, commonly called snow blindness. Symptoms may appear hours after exposure and usually improve as the cornea heals.

Alternate Names:
Snow Blindness; Photokeratitis

CHIP

Clonal hematopoiesis of indeterminate potential: an age-related finding in which blood-forming cells

acquire a gene change and expand without meeting criteria for a blood cancer. It can increase the future risk of myeloid cancer and cardiovascular disease and may require monitoring.

Chiropody

Care of the feet, including assessment and treatment of skin, nail, pressure, and biomechanical problems.

Alternate Names:
Podiatry

Chiropractic

A healthcare practice that mainly uses hands-on treatment for muscle, joint, and spine problems, especially spinal manipulation. Benefits and risks vary by the condition, technique, and practitioner's training.

Chiropractic Care For Back Pain

Manual therapy, primarily spinal manipulation and mobilization, provided for acute and chronic low back pain when indicated. Evidence supports its use for acute low back pain in particular, though it is not appropriate for all causes of back pain.

Chiropractor

A healthcare practitioner who provides manual or manipulative treatment, especially for musculoskeletal conditions, according to the practitioner's training and local regulation.

Alternate Names:
Chiropractic Practitioner; Chiropractic Clinician

Chitin

A strong natural substance forming the cell walls of fungi and the outer coverings of insects, spiders, and shellfish. Humans do not digest it, but exposure to chitin-containing material can contribute to allergic or airway irritation in some people.

Chlamydia

In common clinical use, an infection with *Chlamydia trachomatis*, a sexually transmitted bacterium that often causes no symptoms but may cause discharge, painful urination, pelvic inflammatory disease, infertility, eye infection, or newborn infection. The word can also refer to the bacterial genus, which includes species causing respiratory or bird-associated infections.

Chlamydiaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Chlamydia species. Some cause sexually transmitted infections, eye disease, or respiratory infection; diagnosis depends on the species, specimen, symptoms, and laboratory testing.

Chlamydia (Chlamydial Genitourinary Infections)

Genitourinary infection caused by Chlamydia trachomatis, often without symptoms. Untreated infection can cause cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, ectopic pregnancy, infertility, or neonatal infection; testing, treatment, and partner management are important.

Chlamydial Pneumonia

An atypical pneumonia caused by obligate intracellular bacteria of the genus *Chlamydia* or *Chlamydophila*. Major etiologic species include *Chlamydophila pneumoniae* (causing community-acquired pneumonia in adults and adolescents characterized by biphasic illness with pharyngitis and hoarseness followed by persistent nonproductive cough and subsegmental infiltrates), *Chlamydia trachomatis* (causing afebrile pneumonia in infants aged 1–3 months marked by a classic staccato cough, tachypnea, hyperinflated lungs, and peripheral eosinophilia), and *Chlamydophila psittaci* (psittacosis acquired via bird exposure, presenting with severe headache, high fever, and hepatosplenomegaly). First-line treatment across etiologies consists of macrolides (azithromycin) or tetracyclines (doxycycline).

Chlamydial Pneumonias

Plural form; see *Chlamydial Pneumonia*.

Chlamydia Pneumoniae Infection

A respiratory infection caused by Chlamydia pneumoniae, formerly called Chlamydophila pneumoniae. It commonly causes gradual-onset atypical pneumo-

nia, bronchitis, or upper-respiratory symptoms.

Chlamydia Psittaci

A bacterium that causes psittacosis, a zoonotic infection usually acquired by inhaling organisms from infected birds.

Chlamydia Trachomatis

A bacterium that commonly causes sexually transmitted infection of the urogenital tract and can also cause conjunctivitis or pneumonia.

Chlamydial Urethritis

Inflammation of the urethra caused by the sexually transmitted bacterium *Chlamydia trachomatis*. It may cause burning during urination or discharge, but many people have no symptoms.

Candidal Balanitis

Inflammation of the glans penis caused by Candida yeast; see *Balanitis*.

Chlamydia Trachomatis Infection

A bacterial infection spread mainly through sexual contact. It often causes no symptoms but may cause discharge or painful urination and can lead to pelvic inflammatory disease, infertility, eye infection, or newborn infection.

Chlamydiosis

Infection caused by bacteria of the genus Chlamydia. Depending on the species and site, it may cause sexually transmitted infection, conjunctivitis, pneumonia, or other disease.

Chloasma

Patchy brown or gray-brown darkening of the skin, usually on the face. It is often related to pregnancy, hormones, and sunlight and is commonly called melasma.

Alternate Names:
Melasma; Mask of Pregnancy

Chloracne

An acne-like eruption caused by exposure to certain halogenated aromatic compounds, such as dioxins and related industrial chemicals.

Chloral Hydrate

A sedative-hypnotic compound with limited modern use because of toxicity, dependence, respiratory depression, and cardiac or gastrointestinal adverse effects.

Chlorambucil

An oral chemotherapy medicine that damages DNA and is used mainly for some chronic leukemias and lymphomas. It can lower blood counts and increase infection risk.

Chloramphenicol

An antibiotic that stops bacteria from making essential proteins. It is reserved for selected serious infections when safer or more suitable medicines are unavailable because it can rarely cause dangerous bone-marrow suppression and other severe effects.

Chloranemia

An older term for anemia in which red blood cells contain too little hemoglobin and appear unusually pale. Iron deficiency is a common cause; modern evaluation uses blood counts and iron studies.

Chlordane

A persistent organochlorine insecticide formerly used for termite control; exposure can affect the nervous system and liver and has environmental persistence.

Chlordecone

A persistent organochlorine pesticide that can cause neurologic, reproductive, and liver effects after significant exposure and remains in the environment for long periods.

Chlordiazepoxide

A benzodiazepine medicine that slows brain activity and may be used short term for alcohol-withdrawal symptoms or severe anxiety. It can cause drowsiness, dependence, impaired coordination, and dangerous

breathing suppression with alcohol or opioids.

Chlordiazepoxide Overdose

Overdose of chlordiazepoxide, a benzodiazepine, that can cause drowsiness, impaired coordination, respiratory depression, and coma, especially with other sedatives.

Chlorethoxyfos

An organophosphate insecticide that can block a nerve enzyme, causing sweating, vomiting, weakness, breathing problems, seizures, or other poisoning symptoms after exposure.

Chlorfenvinphos

An organophosphate insecticide that can cause cholinergic toxicity by inhibiting acetylcholinesterase; use is restricted or prohibited in many places.

Chlorhexidine

A broad-spectrum antiseptic used for skin, mucosal, and oral preparation; it can cause irritation, allergy, or rare severe anaphylaxis.

Chloride

A negatively charged mineral in blood and other body fluids. It works with sodium and other electrolytes to control fluid balance, nerve and muscle function, and the body's acid level.

Chloride Channel

A protein forming a passage for chloride ions across a cell membrane. Chloride channels help control electrical signals, fluid movement, and muscle or nerve function.

Chloride In Diet

Chloride consumed in food, usually as part of salt. It helps maintain fluid balance, nerve signals, and stomach acid; excessive intake often accompanies excess sodium.

Chloride Ion

The negatively charged form of chlorine and a major extracellular electrolyte that helps maintain fluid balance, osmotic pressure, acid–base status, and electrical neutrality.

Chloride Shift

An electrochemical exchange process in red blood cells mediated by the anion exchanger 1 (band 3 protein), wherein bicarbonate generated by carbonic anhydrase exits the erythrocyte in exchange for an incoming plasma chloride ion in systemic capillaries, reversed in pulmonary capillaries.

Alternate Names:
Hamburger Phenomenon

Chloride Test

A blood or urine laboratory test measuring chloride, a major extracellular anion vital for maintaining fluid balance, blood volume, and acid-base equilibrium; see *Chloride* and *Basic Metabolic Panel*.

Chlorinated Lime

Chlorinated lime, or bleaching powder, releases chlorine and is used as a disinfectant; concentrated exposure can burn skin, eyes, and airways.

Chlorinated Lime Poisoning

Exposure to chlorinated lime, a hypochlorite-containing corrosive that can injure the skin, eyes, airways, or gastrointestinal tract.

Chlorine

A reactive halogen element and disinfectant; inhalation of chlorine gas can injure the eyes and airways and cause chemical pneumonitis or pulmonary edema.

Chlorine Poisoning

Inhalation or contact exposure to chlorine gas, which irritates the eyes and airways and can cause cough, bronchospasm, chemical pneumonitis, or pulmonary edema.

Chlormadinone Acetate

A synthetic progestogen used in some hormonal medicines; effects and risks include changes in bleed-

ing, mood, metabolism, and thrombotic risk depending on the formulation.

Chlormethine

Chlormethine, or mechlorethamine, is an alkylating anticancer drug used systemically or topically for selected cancers and cutaneous T-cell lymphoma.

Chlorodeoxyadenosine

Another name for cladribine, a purine-analog medicine used for selected blood cancers and multiple sclerosis; prolonged lymphocyte suppression and infection risk are important considerations.

Chloroform

A volatile solvent and environmental contaminant that can irritate the lungs and nervous system and damage the liver or kidneys after significant exposure.

Chlorogenic Acid

A natural plant compound found in coffee, fruits, and vegetables. It has antioxidant effects in laboratory studies, but evidence is insufficient to use supplements to prevent or treat disease.

Chloroleukemia

A rare form of myeloid leukaemia associated with greenish masses of abnormal immature blood-forming cells outside the bone marrow. These masses are also called myeloid sarcoma or chloroma.

Alternate Names:
Granulocytic Sarcoma; Chloroma; Myeloid Sarcoma

Chloroma

A mass of immature myeloid blood-forming cells growing outside the bone marrow, usually associated with acute myeloid leukaemia. It may affect skin, bone, lymph nodes, or internal organs and is also called myeloid sarcoma.

Alternate Names:
Myeloid Sarcoma; Granulocytic Sarcoma; Extramedullary Myeloid Tumor

Chlorophyllin

A water-soluble, copper-containing derivative of chlorophyll used in some products and studied for effects such as odor control; clinical uses depend on evidence and context.

Alternate Names:
Chlorophyllin Copper Complex; Sodium Copper Chlorophyllin

Chlorophyll Poisoning

Ingestion of chlorophyll-containing products, which usually causes mild gastrointestinal effects; product ingredients and dose determine clinical risk.

Chloropicrin

A pungent soil fumigant and irritant that can injure the eyes, skin, and respiratory tract after exposure.

Chloroprene

An industrial chemical used to make chloroprene rubber; repeated or high exposure can irritate tissues and has carcinogenic concern.

Chloropsia

A visual disturbance in which objects appear green or greenish. It may result from retinal or visual-pathway disease, medicines, toxins, migraine, or other conditions; onset may be sudden or persistent.

Chloroquine

An antimalarial medicine used for susceptible Plasmodium species and selected autoimmune conditions; retinal toxicity, cardiotoxicity, and drug interactions require attention.

Chlorothiazide

A thiazide diuretic used to treat high blood pressure and fluid retention. It increases urine production and may cause low sodium, low potassium, dehydration, or high blood sugar.

Chlorpheniramine

A first-generation antihistamine used for allergy symptoms; drowsiness, dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, and other anticholinergic effects

may occur.

Chlorphentermine

An older stimulant appetite suppressant related to amphetamines; it is not routinely used because of cardiovascular, psychiatric, and dependence risks.

Chlorpromazine

A first-generation antipsychotic and phenothiazine used for schizophrenia, severe nausea, and selected other conditions; adverse effects include sedation, hypotension, movement disorders, and QT prolongation.

Chlorpromazine Overdose

Overdose of chlorpromazine that may cause sedation, hypotension, anticholinergic effects, seizures, cardiac conduction abnormalities, or neuroleptic malignant syndrome.

Chlorpropamide

A first-generation sulfonylurea that lowers blood glucose by stimulating pancreatic insulin release; prolonged hypoglycemia and hyponatremia are important risks.

Chlorpyrifos

An organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase; significant exposure can cause cholinergic toxicity with secretions, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, or seizures.

Chlortalidone

Chlortalidone, also called chlorthalidone, is a long-acting thiazide-like diuretic used mainly for hypertension and fluid retention.

Chlorthalidone

A long-acting thiazide-like diuretic used for hypertension and edema; it can cause hyponatremia, hypokalemia, hyperuricemia, and kidney-related electrolyte changes.

Chlorzoxazone

A centrally acting muscle relaxant used for painful muscle spasm in some countries; drowsiness and rare serious liver injury are important risks.

Choanal Atresia

A birth defect in which tissue blocks one or both passages from the nose to the throat. Blockage on both sides can cause severe breathing difficulty in a newborn, especially during feeding.

CHO Cell

A Chinese hamster ovary cell line widely used to produce recombinant proteins, antibodies, vaccines, and other biologic medicines.

Chocolate Cyst

A chocolate cyst is an ovarian endometrioma filled with old blood from endometriosis, which can cause pelvic pain, infertility, or an adnexal mass.

Choice Behavior

The process of selecting among alternatives, studied in psychology and neuroscience to understand decision-making, impulsivity, and reward processing. Abnormal choice behavior may be relevant to addiction, eating disorders, and psychiatric conditions.

Choke

Airway blockage by food or another object that prevents normal airflow and can rapidly cause inability to speak, cyanosis, loss of consciousness, or death.

Choking

Blockage of the airway by food or another object, making breathing difficult or impossible. Severe obstruction can prevent speaking, effective coughing, or breathing.

Choking First Aid for Adults and Children

Immediate emergency management for complete foreign-body airway obstruction (FBAO) in conscious adults and children over 1 year of age, utilizing subdiaphragmatic abdominal thrusts (Heimlich maneuver) or alternating back blows and chest thrusts.

Alternate Names:
Heimlich Maneuver; Foreign Body Airway Obstruction Management; FBAO First Aid

Choking First Aid for an Unresponsive Person

Advanced resuscitation algorithm for an unresponsive patient with foreign body airway obstruction, involving immediate initiation of cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR), visualization of the oral cavity prior to rescue breaths, and avoidance of blind finger sweeps.

Alternate Names:
Unconscious Choking Management; Obstructed Airway CPR; Foreign Body CPR

Choking First Aid for Infants

Emergency rescue intervention for complete foreign-body airway obstruction in conscious infants under 1 year of age, consisting of 5 prone back blows delivered between the scapulae followed by 5 supine chest thrusts while firmly supporting the head.

Alternate Names:
Infant Choking Management; Infant Foreign Body Airway Relief; Infant FBAO

Cholagogue

A substance that encourages the gallbladder to release bile into the small intestine. Bile helps the body digest fats; gallstones or blocked bile ducts can affect the action or safety of cholagogues.

Alternate Names:
Gallbladder Stimulant; Biliary Evacuant

Cholangiitis

Inflammation of the tubes that carry bile from the liver and gallbladder to the intestine. Infection, a blockage, autoimmune disease, or another bile-duct disorder may cause it.

Cholangiocarcinoma

A cancer arising from the cells lining the bile ducts, classified as intrahepatic, perihilar, or distal by location. Perihilar and distal tumors may obstruct bile flow and cause jaundice, itching, dark urine, or pale stools; intrahepatic tumors may present as a liver mass or with nonspecific symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Bile Duct Cancer; Cholangiocellular Carcinoma

Cholangiography

Imaging of the bile ducts after contrast material makes them visible. It can show gallstones, narrowing, leaks, or blockage and may be performed during surgery, through the skin, or during endoscopy.

Cholangiohepatitis

Inflammation of the bile ducts and liver, often caused by infection, blockage, parasites, or repeated bile-duct inflammation. It may cause fever, pain under the right ribs, jaundice, abnormal liver tests, and sometimes serious infection.

Cholangitis

Inflammation or infection of the tubes that carry bile from the liver and gallbladder to the intestine. A blockage from a gallstone or narrowing can cause fever, pain, jaundice, and rapidly worsening bloodstream infection.

Cholate

The ionized form of cholic acid, a primary bile acid that helps emulsify dietary fat and is conjugated and secreted by the liver.

Cholecalciferol

Vitamin D3, produced in skin by ultraviolet light and obtained from food or supplements, then converted to active metabolites that regulate calcium and phosphate.

Cholecyst

The gallbladder, a small sac beneath the liver that stores and concentrates bile. When food enters the intestine, it contracts and releases bile to help digest dietary fats.

Cholecystectomy

Surgery to remove the gallbladder, a small organ under the liver that stores bile. It may be needed for painful gallstones, gallbladder inflammation,

gallstone-related pancreatitis, or selected polyps. It is often done through small cuts using a camera, but open surgery may be needed when this is not safe. Bile still flows from the liver into the intestine after surgery.

Alternate Names:
Gallbladder Removal

Cholecystitis

Inflammation of the gallbladder, which may be acute or chronic. Acute cholecystitis is most often caused by a gallstone blocking the cystic duct, but it can occur without stones, particularly in critically ill people. It causes persistent upper-right abdominal pain and may involve fever, nausea, and vomiting. Repeated inflammation can scar the gallbladder.

Cholecystography

An imaging test of the gallbladder after contrast material is given to show how it fills, concentrates bile, and empties. Ultrasound, CT, or other modern tests are usually preferred for current gallbladder evaluation.

Cholecystokinin

A hormone released by the small intestine after food, especially fat and protein, enters it. It makes the gallbladder release bile, stimulates digestive enzymes, and helps create a feeling of fullness.

Cholecystoses

Non-inflammatory disorders causing deposits, wall thickening, or other structural changes in the gallbladder, including cholesterolosis and adenomyomatosis. Many are incidental, but symptoms and imaging findings determine whether further evaluation is needed.

Cholecystostomy

Drainage of the gallbladder through a catheter or other route, commonly performed percutaneously under imaging guidance. It relieves gallbladder distension and drains bile; it does not necessarily create a permanent surgical opening or stoma.

Choledochal Cyst

A congenital cystic dilatation of the extrahepatic or intrahepatic biliary ductal system, classified into five types by Todani: Type I (solitary extrahepatic fusiform or saccular dilatation, comprising $> 80\%$ of cases); Type II (extrahepatic bile duct diverticulum); Type III (choledochocele confined to the duodenal wall); Type IV (multiple intra- and extrahepatic cysts); and Type V (Caroli disease, isolated intrahepatic dilatations). Frequently associated with an anomalous pancreaticobiliary ductal junction (APBDJ), promoting pancreatic enzyme reflux into the biliary tree with resultant chronic cholangitis, stone formation, pancreatitis, and an elevated lifetime risk of cholangiocarcinoma. The classic clinical triad of right upper quadrant pain, palpable mass, and jaundice is seen in a minority of patients. Definitive management is complete surgical excision of the extrahepatic cyst and gallbladder with Roux-en-Y hepaticojejunostomy to prevent malignant degeneration.

Alternate Names:
Choledochal Cysts; Biliary Duct Cysts

Choledochal Cysts

Plural form; see *Choledochal Cyst*.

Choledocholithiasis

One or more gallstones in the common bile duct. The stones usually move there from the gallbladder but can form in the duct. They may cause no symptoms unless they obstruct bile flow; obstruction can cause abdominal pain or jaundice and may lead to bile-duct infection (cholangitis) or pancreatitis.

Cholelithiasis

The presence of one or more stones in the gallbladder. The stones are usually made mainly of cholesterol, bilirubin pigment, or a mixture; they may cause no symptoms or block a bile duct and cause pain or other complications.

Cholera

An acute intestinal infection caused by toxigenic *Vibrio cholerae*, usually acquired through contaminated water or food. It can produce sudden profuse wa-

tery diarrhoea, vomiting, severe dehydration, shock, and death within hours if untreated. Rehydration is central to treatment; safe water, sanitation, food hygiene, and vaccination in selected settings reduce spread.

Choleresis

The production and release of bile by liver cells. Bile helps digest fats and carries some waste products from the liver into the intestine.

Choleretic

A substance that encourages the liver to make or release bile. Bile helps digest fats and remove some waste products; gallstones or blocked bile ducts can affect its action or safety.

Alternate Names:
Bile-Secretory Agent; Bile-Flow Stimulant

Cholestasis

Reduced production or flow of bile. It may cause itching, yellow skin or eyes, dark urine, pale stools, and abnormal liver tests; a blockage and liver-cell causes must be distinguished.

Alternate Names:
Biliary Stasis

Cholestasis Of Pregnancy

A pregnancy-related liver disorder in which bile acids build up in the blood and often cause intense itching without a rash, especially on the palms and soles. It can increase risks to the fetus, so testing and obstetric monitoring are important.

Cholesteatoma

A growth of trapped skin cells in the middle ear or bone behind the ear. It can cause repeated smelly ear discharge and hearing loss, and may damage nearby bone or other structures if it grows.

Cholesterol

A lipid required for cell membranes and synthesis of steroid hormones and bile acids. Excess atherogenic cholesterol can contribute to arterial plaque.

Cholesterol And Lifestyle

Diet, physical activity, weight, smoking, and alcohol use can affect blood cholesterol and cardiovascular risk. Lifestyle changes complement medicines when cholesterol remains high.

Cholesterol And Lipids

Fatty substances in the blood, including LDL cholesterol, HDL cholesterol, and triglycerides, that play critical roles in cellular function and energy metabolism. Abnormal lipid levels, particularly high LDL and triglycerides with low HDL, promote atherosclerosis and increase the risk of heart attack and stroke.

Cholesterol Crystal Embolization

Small pieces of cholesterol plaque breaking loose from a large artery and blocking smaller arteries. It may damage the kidneys, skin, eyes, brain, or intestines, often after a vascular procedure.

Cholesterol Crystals

Needle-shaped or rhomboid cholesterol deposits within atherosclerotic plaques. If released from a plaque, they can lodge in small arteries and cause cholesterol crystal embolization, reducing blood flow and provoking inflammation in affected tissues.

Cholesterol Emboli

Cholesterol crystals released from an atherosclerotic plaque that lodge in small arteries and cause ischemia or inflammation in downstream tissues.

Cholesterol Embolism

Blockage of small arteries by cholesterol crystals released from an artery wall, often after vascular procedures or disruption of atherosclerotic plaque.

Cholesterol Embolization

A condition in which tiny pieces of fatty material from an artery wall break loose and travel into smaller blood vessels. It can damage the kidneys, skin, eyes, brain, or intestines, sometimes after a vascular procedure or blood-thinning treatment.

Cholesterolemia

The presence and concentration of cholesterol in the blood. Abnormal elevation is a risk factor for atherosclerotic cardiovascular disease.

Cholesterol Lowering

Reduction of cholesterol concentrations in blood, usually through changes in lipid metabolism or treatment. It is an intended therapeutic effect and is not synonymous with hyperlipidemia, which means elevated concentrations of cholesterol or other blood lipids.

Cholesterolosis

Deposition of cholesterol esters in the gallbladder mucosa, producing yellow speckling or a "strawberry gallbladder." It is often incidental but may coexist with gallstones or chronic gallbladder inflammation.

Cholesterol Synthesis

The process by which cells, especially liver and intestinal cells, make cholesterol from smaller molecules. Cholesterol is needed for cell membranes, hormones, and bile acids, but excess production contributes to high blood cholesterol.

Cholesterol Test

A blood test measuring circulating cholesterol fractions—including LDL, HDL, and total cholesterol—to estimate cardiovascular disease risk; see *Cholesterol* and *Lipid Profile*.

Cholesterol Testing And Results

Laboratory assessment of blood lipids, usually including total cholesterol, LDL cholesterol, HDL cholesterol, and triglycerides, used to estimate cardiovascular risk and guide prevention or treatment.

Cholestyramine

Cholestyramine is a bile-acid sequestrant used to lower LDL cholesterol and sometimes to treat bile-acid diarrhea or itching from cholestasis.

Choline

Choline is an essential nutrient used to make cell membranes and acetylcholine and to support liver and nervous-system function.

Cholinergic

Relating to acetylcholine, a chemical messenger used by nerves. Cholinergic signals affect muscles, glands, the heart, digestion, breathing, and parts of the brain.

Cholinergic Crisis

A life-threatening excess of acetylcholine, often after organophosphate or carbamate poisoning. It can cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, pinpoint pupils, wheezing, muscle weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

Cholinergic Neuron

A nerve cell that releases acetylcholine as its principal neurotransmitter.

Alternate Names:
Acetylcholine-Releasing Neuron; Cholinergic Nerve Cell

Cholinergic Toxidrome

A poisoning pattern caused by excessive acetylcholine activity, often producing salivation, tearing, urination, diarrhea, vomiting, bronchial secretions, slow heart rate, muscle fasciculations, weakness, or respiratory failure.

Cholinergic Urticaria

A chronic inducible urticaria triggered by increased body temperature or sweating, such as during exercise, hot bathing, spicy food, or emotional stress. It causes numerous small, short-lived itchy wheals, sometimes with flushing or angioedema; rare breathing or circulatory symptoms require emergency care.

Cholinesterase

Cholinesterase enzymes break down acetylcholine; inhibition increases cholinergic activity and is used therapeutically but can also cause poisoning.

Chondritis

Inflammation of cartilage, such as the cartilage of the ear, nose, ribs, or larynx. It may result from infection, trauma, or immune-mediated disease.

Chondroblastic Osteosarcoma

A type of bone cancer in which the cancer cells make cartilage-like material. It often affects the widened ends of long bones in adolescents and young adults and is diagnosed from imaging and a tissue sample.

Chondroblastoma

A chondroblastoma is an uncommon usually benign cartilage-forming bone tumor, often arising near the end of a long bone in adolescents or young adults.

Chondrocalcinosis

Calcium-crystal deposits in cartilage or other joint tissues that appear on imaging. They are often linked to calcium pyrophosphate deposition disease and may cause joint pain and swelling or be found without symptoms.

Chondrocyte

A mature cell that makes and maintains cartilage, the firm flexible tissue found in joints, airways, and other places. Chondrocytes help keep cartilage smooth and strong, but cartilage usually heals slowly because it has little direct blood supply.

Alternate Names:
Cartilage Cell

Chondrodermatitis Nodularis Helicis

A painful inflammatory nodule affecting the skin and cartilage of the ear's helix or antihelix, often related to repeated pressure, sleeping on one side, cold, sun, or local trauma. A firm tender crusted lesion can resemble skin cancer, so persistent or atypical lesions may need biopsy; pressure relief is an important treatment.

Chondrodysplasia

A disorder of cartilage and bone development that causes abnormal skeletal growth. Depending on the type, it may produce short limbs, short stature, enlarged joints, or other bone abnormalities.

Chondrodysplasia Punctata

A group of disorders of cartilage and bone development marked by punctate, or stippled, calcifications near the ends of bones or in cartilage on imaging. The pattern and severity vary by subtype; possible features include shortened limbs, distinctive facial features, cataracts, or respiratory problems. The term describes a radiographic and clinical group, not one single genetic disorder.

Chondroitin Sulfate

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan found in cartilage and other connective tissues; it is also marketed in supplements for osteoarthritis, with variable evidence of benefit.

Chondroma

A usually harmless tumour made of mature cartilage. It most often forms inside a bone, especially in the hands and feet, or on the bone surface. Many cause no symptoms; some cause pain, growth, or fracture.

Chondromalacia

Softening or breakdown of cartilage, especially the cartilage under the kneecap. It may cause pain at the front of the knee, grinding, or discomfort with stairs, squatting, or prolonged sitting.

Chondromalacia Patellae

Softening or damage to the cartilage under the kneecap. It may cause pain at the front of the knee, especially when climbing stairs, squatting, or sitting with the knee bent for a long time.

Chondromyxoid Fibroma

A rare benign cartilage-forming bone tumor, usually arising in the metaphysis of a long bone and presenting with localized pain or an incidental radiographic lesion.

Chondrosarcoma

A cancer that forms cartilage, usually within a bone. It is more common in adults and often grows slowly,

though some types can grow faster or spread. Rarely, it begins in soft tissue rather than bone.

Chondrosarcoma Of The Breast

An extremely rare breast cancer whose cells produce cartilage-like tissue. It usually appears as a growing breast mass and is diagnosed by examining tissue; treatment generally requires complete surgical removal by a specialist team.

Chopart's Joint

The combined joint across the middle of the foot, between the hindfoot and midfoot. It includes the talonavicular and calcaneocuboid joints and helps the foot adapt to surfaces and transfer force during walking.

Chorangioma

A benign vascular tumor of the placenta, usually small and incidental but occasionally associated with fetal anemia, hydrops, growth restriction, or other complications when large.

Chordae Tendineae

Strong, thin cords inside the heart that connect the mitral and tricuspid valves to small muscles. They help keep the valves from turning inside out when the heart contracts.

Chordee

Chordee is abnormal downward or other curvature of the penis, commonly associated with hypospadias or scar tissue and sometimes requiring surgical correction.

Chordoma

A rare, usually slow-growing malignant tumor arising from embryonic notochordal remnants in the axial skeleton. It most often develops in the sacrum near the tailbone, the skull base, or another vertebra and can invade nearby tissues, causing pain or neurologic symptoms.

Chorea

Uncontrolled, brief, irregular movements that flow unpredictably from one body part to another. It may result from inherited disease, autoimmune illness, medicines, infection, or damage to movement-control areas of the brain.

Chorea and Myoclonus

Two distinct types of involuntary movement. Chorea consists of brief, irregular movements that flow unpredictably between body parts; myoclonus consists of sudden, shock-like muscle jerks. Either may occur in neurologic or metabolic disorders, and the terms are not synonyms.

Choreoathetosis

A movement disorder combining brief, unpredictable jerks with slower twisting movements. It can result from injury or disease affecting movement-control areas deep in the brain, inherited conditions, or certain medicines.

Chorioamnionitis

Infection or inflammation of the amniotic fluid, membranes, placenta, or decidua, usually due to ascending polymicrobial infection. Maternal fever, uterine tenderness, fetal tachycardia, and maternal leukocytosis may occur; treatment requires broad-spectrum antibiotics and delivery planning.

Alternate Names:
Intraamniotic Infection

Choriocarcinoma

A fast-growing cancer arising from cells that normally help form the placenta. It usually develops after a pregnancy or molar pregnancy and produces high levels of the pregnancy hormone hCG; it can spread but often responds well to chemotherapy.

Chorion

The outer membrane surrounding an early embryo. Its finger-like projections help form the fetal part of the placenta, where oxygen, nutrients, and waste are exchanged between fetal and maternal blood supplies.

Chorionic Gonadotrophin

Chorionic gonadotrophin, especially hCG, is a pla-

cental hormone that maintains early pregnancy and is measured in pregnancy tests and selected tumor evaluations.

Chorionic Villus Sampling

A prenatal test usually performed around 10 to 13 weeks by removing a small placental sample through the abdomen or cervix. It can identify many chromosome and inherited disorders but carries a small miscarriage risk.

Chorion Villus Sampling

Chorion villus sampling removes placental tissue for genetic or chromosomal testing, usually early in pregnancy; it carries a small procedure-related miscarriage risk.

Chorioretinitis

Inflammation involving the choroid and retina, often caused by infection, autoimmune disease, or systemic inflammatory illness. It can produce floaters and impaired vision.

Choroid

The blood-vessel-rich layer between the retina and the white outer coat of the eye. It supplies oxygen and nutrients to the outer retina and helps absorb stray light inside the eye.

Choroidal Dystrophies

Inherited disorders causing progressive degeneration of the choroid, retinal pigment epithelium, and retina, leading to night blindness, visual-field loss, and eventual vision impairment.

Choroidal Melanoma

A cancer arising from pigment-producing melanocytes in the choroid, the vascular layer beneath the retina. It may cause visual changes or be found incidentally and can spread, especially to the liver; treatment depends on size and location.

Choroidal Neovascularization

Pathologic growth of new blood vessels from the choroid through Bruch membrane into the space beneath the retinal pigment epithelium or the subretinal space. These vessels may leak or bleed, causing retinal damage, scarring, and central vision loss. It is associated with neovascular age-related macular degeneration, pathologic myopia, and some inflammatory eye diseases.

Alternate Names:
Choroidal Neovascularisation; CNV

Choroideremia

An X-linked inherited chorioretinal dystrophy caused by pathogenic variants in *CHM*, leading to progressive degeneration of the retinal pigment epithelium, photoreceptors, and choroid. Affected males typically develop night blindness followed by progressive peripheral visual-field loss; central vision is often preserved until later. Heterozygous females are usually asymptomatic but may show retinal changes.

Choroiditis

Inflammation of the choroid, the blood-vessel-rich layer between the retina and the outer wall of the eye. It is a form of posterior uveitis and may occur with inflammation of the retina; symptoms can include floaters, blurred vision, or blind spots.

Choroid Plexus

A network of tissue inside the brain's ventricles that produces most of the cerebrospinal fluid.

Choroid Plexus Carcinoma

A cancer arising from the choroid plexus, tissue that produces cerebrospinal fluid, potentially causing pressure buildup, headaches, vomiting, or neurologic problems.

Choroid Plexus Cyst

A fluid-filled cyst within the choroid plexus of a fetal cerebral ventricle. An isolated cyst with otherwise reassuring prenatal assessment is usually benign, but its significance depends on other ultrasound findings and screening results.

Choroid Plexus Tumor

A growth arising from the tissue that makes cere-

brospinal fluid inside the brain. It occurs most often in children and may block fluid flow or produce too much fluid, causing hydrocephalus, headache, vomiting, or increasing head size.

Christmas Disease

An inherited bleeding disorder, also called hemophilia B, caused by low or abnormal clotting factor IX. It can cause prolonged bleeding or bleeding into joints and muscles and is treated with replacement or other specialist therapy.

Chromaffin

Describes cells that contain stored adrenaline-like hormones. They are found mainly in the inner part of the adrenal glands and in related nerve tissue and release these hormones during stress or in response to nerve signals.

Chromaffinoma

A tumor of cells that can produce adrenaline-like hormones, usually in the adrenal gland or nearby nerve tissue. Hormone release may cause episodes of high blood pressure, headache, sweating, and palpitations.

Chromate

Chromate is a hexavalent chromium compound that can cause irritant or allergic dermatitis, nasal injury, respiratory disease, and cancer after occupational exposure.

Chromatic

Chromatic means relating to color or wavelengths of light; chromatic vision depends on cone photoreceptors and neural processing.

Chromatids

Chromatids are the two copies of a replicated chromosome joined at the centromere before separating during cell division.

Chromatin

The combination of DNA and proteins that packages genetic material inside the cell nucleus. Its arrangement controls which genes are available for use and helps regulate DNA copying and repair.

Chromatography

A laboratory separation method in which substances partition between a stationary phase and a moving phase, allowing identification or measurement of components in a mixture.

Chromatopsia

A visual disturbance in which objects appear abnormally colored. It may result from retinal disease, toxic exposure, medication effects, or other disorders of the visual system.

Chromhidrosis

A rare disorder in which coloured sweat, often yellow, green, blue, or black, appears because pigment is produced in apocrine glands. Similar discoloration can result when ordinary sweat becomes coloured by surface bacteria or chemicals, a process called pseudochromhidrosis; evaluation distinguishes these causes and looks for an underlying medicine or skin disorder.

Chromium

Chromium is a metallic element; trivalent chromium is a trace nutrient, while hexavalent compounds can be toxic, corrosive, mutagenic, and carcinogenic.

Chromium In Diet

Reference information on chromium as a trace element involved in carbohydrate and fat metabolism. Chromium deficiency is rare; most people obtain adequate chromium from normal dietary intake, and routine chromium supplementation is generally not recommended.

Chromoblastomycosis

A chronic implantation infection caused by pigmented fungi, usually after minor trauma introduces the organism into skin. It produces slowly enlarging warty, scaly, or tumorous plaques, most often on the legs; biopsy may show muriform bodies, and prolonged antifungal treatment is often required.

Chromopertubation

A fertility test performed during laparoscopy in which colored fluid is passed through the uterus while the fallopian tubes are viewed. Fluid spilling from the tube ends suggests that they are open; no spill may indicate blockage or surrounding scar tissue.

Chromosomal Abnormality

A change in the number or structure of chromosomes. It may involve an extra or missing chromosome, or a missing, repeated, rearranged, or exchanged chromosome segment, and can affect development, health, or fertility.

Chromosomal Breakage Syndromes

A group of inherited DNA-repair disorders in which chromosomes are unusually fragile or break easily. They may cause congenital anomalies, growth or developmental problems, bone-marrow failure, immune abnormalities, and increased cancer risk.

Chromosomal Microarray

A genetic test that detects gains and losses of chromosome material, including copy-number variants and some regions of homozygosity; it is commonly used for developmental delay, intellectual disability, congenital anomalies, or autism-spectrum presentations.

Chromosome

A thread-like structure made of DNA and proteins that carries genetic information. Most human body cells normally contain 46 chromosomes arranged in 23 pairs.

Chromosome 1

The largest human chromosome, containing many genes involved in development, cell function, and disease. Extra, missing, or rearranged material can cause genetic disorders.

Chromosome 13

A human chromosome containing genes important for development and cell function. Abnormal chromosome 13 number or structure can cause disorders such as trisomy 13.

Chromosome 2

A large human chromosome containing many genes involved in growth, development, and normal body function. Changes in its number or structure can cause genetic disease.

Chromosome 3

A human chromosome containing genes involved in development, immune function, and cell regulation. Deletions, duplications, or other changes may cause genetic disorders or cancer.

Chromosome 4

A human chromosome containing many genes involved in development and cellular function. Structural or numerical abnormalities can cause congenital or inherited conditions.

Chromosome 5

A human chromosome containing genes involved in development, immunity, and cell regulation. Loss of part of its short arm causes the genetic condition cri-du-chat syndrome.

Chromosome Complement

The complete set of chromosomes in a cell, including their number and sex-chromosome composition, usually described by a karyotype.

Chromosome Duplication

A structural chromosome abnormality in which a segment of genetic material is copied one or more additional times, potentially altering gene dosage and development.

Chromosome X

One of the human sex chromosomes. Most females have two X chromosomes and most males have one X and one Y; genes on the X chromosome can cause X-linked disorders when altered.

Chromosome Y

The sex chromosome typically present in most males

and absent in most females. It contains the sex-determining *SRY* gene and other genes important for testis development and sperm production.

Chronic

Persisting or recurring over a long period, in contrast to acute; the appropriate duration depends on the disease or clinical context.

Chronic Adrenal Insufficiency

Long-term inadequate production of adrenal hormones. It may be primary, as in Addison disease, or secondary or tertiary when pituitary or hypothalamic disorders reduce adrenal stimulation.

Chronic Allograft Nephropathy

Gradual loss of function in a transplanted kidney over months or years, caused by immune injury, high blood pressure, recurrent disease, medicines, or other damage. Testing and biopsy help identify the cause.

Chronic Atrophic Gastritis

Long-term inflammation that destroys glands in the stomach lining. It may reduce stomach acid and intrinsic factor, impair iron or vitamin B12 absorption, and increase the risk of anemia or stomach tumors.

Chronic Autoimmune Hashimoto Thyroiditis

A long-term immune-system attack on the thyroid gland that gradually damages thyroid tissue and often causes too little thyroid hormone. It may produce tiredness, cold intolerance, weight change, or an enlarged thyroid.

Chronic Autoimmune Thyroiditis

Long-term inflammation caused by the immune system attacking the thyroid, usually called Hashimoto thyroiditis. It commonly leads to low thyroid hormone and may be associated with thyroid antibodies.

Chronic Bacterial Prostatitis

A recurring bacterial infection of the prostate that may cause repeated urinary infections, burning or urgent urination, pelvic discomfort, or painful ejaculation. Diagnosis uses urine tests; antibiotic treatment often lasts several weeks.

Alternate Names:
NIH Category II Prostatitis; Recurrent Bacterial Prostatitis

Chronic Bronchitis

A productive cough on most days for at least three months in each of two consecutive years, after other causes are excluded. It is a clinical syndrome associated with airway inflammation and commonly occurs with chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Mucous Bronchitis

Chronic Bronchitis With Cor Pulmonale

Chronic mucus-producing airway disease complicated by high blood pressure in the lung arteries and strain or failure of the right side of the heart (cor pulmonale). Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease is a common underlying cause.

Chronic Bronchitis With Emphysema

Coexisting chronic mucus-producing airway disease and emphysema, in which air sacs in the lungs are damaged. They commonly occur together in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, but spirometry is needed to confirm persistent airflow obstruction.

Chronic Caries

Tooth decay that develops slowly over time. It may cause a firm dark area, a cavity, sensitivity, or no symptoms; without dental treatment, decay can reach the inner tooth, causing pain, infection, or tooth loss.

Chronic Cholecystitis

Repeated or persistent inflammation of the gallbladder, usually related to gallstones and impaired emptying. It may cause episodic right-upper-abdominal pain, nausea, or food intolerance and can lead to

scarring or a contracted gallbladder.

Chronic Compartment Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Chronic Exertional Compartment Syndrome*.

Chronic Coronary Syndrome

Long-term coronary artery disease with stable or recurring symptoms caused by reduced blood flow to the heart muscle. It may occur with exertion or emotional stress and can also be present without symptoms.

Chronic Cough

A cough lasting longer than eight weeks. Common causes include asthma, nasal drainage, acid reflux, smoking, and some blood-pressure medicines.

Alternate Names:
Persistent Cough

Chronic Daily Headaches

Headaches occurring on at least 15 days each month for more than three months. They may reflect chronic migraine, tension-type headache, frequent pain-medicine use, or another disorder.

Chronic Disease

A disease or condition that persists for a prolonged period, often months or years, and may require continuing monitoring or management.

Chronic Ear Infection

A persistent, recurrent, or long-standing infection of the middle ear, often associated with a persistent eardrum perforation and painless or foul-smelling ear drainage.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Middle-Ear Infection

Chronic Endometritis

Long-lasting inflammation of the inner lining of the uterus. It may be linked to infection or tissue left after pregnancy and can cause irregular bleeding, pelvic discomfort, or difficulty becoming pregnant; some people have no symptoms.

Chronic Eosinophilic Leukaemia

A rare blood cancer in which the bone marrow makes too many eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, because of abnormal cell growth. It may cause tiredness, fever, weight loss, an enlarged spleen, or damage to the heart, lungs, nerves, or skin.

Chronic Eosinophilic Pneumonia

A usually noninfectious lung inflammation in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, collect in lung tissue. It often causes weeks of cough, breathlessness, fever, night sweats, or weight loss and may recur after treatment.

Chronic Exertional Compartment Syndrome

Exercise-related increased pressure within a muscle compartment that causes predictable pain, tightness, or neurologic symptoms during activity.

Chronic Fatigue Syndrome

A chronic, multisystem illness marked by substantial reduction in function, fatigue not substantially relieved by rest, post-exertional malaise (worsening of symptoms after exertion), and unrefreshing sleep. Common diagnostic criteria require symptoms for more than 6 months and either cognitive impairment or orthostatic intolerance. It can coexist with other conditions; clinical evaluation also considers other possible causes. No confirmatory test is available.

Alternate Names:
CFS; Myalgic Encephalomyelitis (ME); Systemic Exertion Intolerance Disease (SEID)

Chronic Fever

A fever that continues or repeatedly returns over a long period. Causes include infection, inflammatory disease, cancer, and medicines; pattern and accompanying symptoms help distinguish causes.

Chronic Gastritis

Long-lasting inflammation of the stomach lining, often caused by *Helicobacter pylori* infection or an autoimmune reaction. It may cause no symptoms or upper-abdominal discomfort. In atrophic forms, long-term inflammation can destroy stomach glands

and increase the risk of anemia or stomach cancer. Causes include *Helicobacter pylori* infection and autoimmune gastritis. Depending on the cause and duration, some forms may progress to gland loss, atrophy, or intestinal metaplasia; these changes do not occur in every case.

Chronic Glomerulonephritis

Long-standing inflammation and scarring of the kidney glomeruli that can progressively reduce filtration and lead to chronic kidney disease or kidney failure.

Chronic Granulomatous Disease

An inherited immune disorder in which certain white blood cells cannot effectively kill some bacteria and fungi. It causes repeated serious infections, swollen lymph nodes, pneumonia, skin infections, and inflammation called granulomas.

Chronic Hypertension

Persistently elevated systemic arterial blood pressure present over time, whether due to an identified underlying cause or without an identifiable secondary cause. It is distinct from hypertension arising only during pregnancy.

Chronic Hypertension In Pregnancy

Hypertension that predates pregnancy or is diagnosed early in pregnancy. It increases the risk of preeclampsia, fetal growth problems, preterm birth, and placental complications and requires ongoing maternal and fetal monitoring.

Chronic Idiopathic Constipation

Long-lasting difficult or infrequent bowel movements without an identified structural or metabolic cause. Symptoms may include hard stools, straining, incomplete emptying, or abdominal discomfort; management may include dietary changes, activity, and medicines.

Chronic Constipation

A long-term pattern of difficult or infrequent bowel movements, often with hard stools, straining, or a feeling that the bowel has not emptied fully. Causes include slow movement through the bowel, medicines, other health conditions, or problems with the muscles used to pass stool.

Chronic Diarrhea

Loose or watery stools that continue or keep returning for more than four weeks. It is a symptom rather than a disease and may result from infection, inflammation, poor absorption, food intolerance, medicines, or changes in bowel function.

Chronic Inflammation

Inflammation that continues for weeks, months, or years. It can occur with persistent infection, autoimmune disease, long-term irritation, or obesity and may cause ongoing tissue damage while the body attempts repair.

Chronic Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyneuropathy

An immune disorder that damages the insulating covering of nerves outside the brain and spinal cord. It causes gradually worsening or recurring weakness, numbness, poor balance, and reduced reflexes in the limbs.

Chronic Inflammatory Response Syndrome

A proposed diagnosis linking nonspecific symptoms to exposure to water-damaged buildings. Reported symptoms include fatigue, headache, cognitive difficulty, and respiratory complaints. Its diagnostic criteria and proposed biomarkers have not been independently validated as a distinct clinical syndrome.

Chronic Interstitial Nephritis

Long-term inflammation and scarring of the kidney tissue between the tubules. It may result from medicines, repeated infection, urinary obstruction, toxins, autoimmune disease, or inherited disorders and can gradually reduce kidney function.

Chronic Intestinal Pseudo-Obstruction

Repeated symptoms of bowel blockage without a physical obstruction, caused by poor nerve or muscle

function in the intestine. It may cause abdominal swelling, pain, vomiting, constipation, and inability to absorb nutrition.

Chronicity

How long a disease, symptom, or process has lasted or how long it tends to continue. A condition may be described as acute when it is recent and short-lasting, or chronic when it persists over a long period.

Chronic Kidney Disease

Kidney damage or reduced kidney function that lasts at least three months. Diabetes and high blood pressure are common causes. Early disease may cause no symptoms; later it can cause swelling, tiredness, poor appetite, nausea, or kidney failure. It differs from sudden kidney injury.

Alternate Names:
CKD; Chronic Renal Disease

Chronic Kidney Disease-Mineral and Bone Disorder

A systemic disorder of mineral and bone metabolism resulting from chronic kidney disease, characterized by abnormalities of calcium, phosphorus, parathyroid hormone, or vitamin D metabolism; abnormalities in bone turnover, mineralization, linear growth, or strength (renal osteodystrophy); and extra-skeletal vascular or soft-tissue calcification.

Alternate Names:
CKD-MBD; Renal Mineral and Bone Disorder

Chronic Kidney Disease Progression

Worsening loss of kidney function or increasing kidney damage over time. Progression is assessed with trends in estimated glomerular filtration rate, albumin in urine, blood pressure, symptoms, and other findings.

Chronic Kidney Disease Staging

Classification of kidney disease by cause, eGFR category, and albuminuria category. G1 through G5 represent eGFR from normal or high to kidney failure; staging is applied when abnormalities persist for at least 3 months and helps estimate progression and complications.

Chronic Kidney Failure

Kidney failure lasting more than three months, generally corresponding to a glomerular filtration rate below 15 mL/min/1.73 m^2 or ongoing kidney replacement therapy. It is an advanced state of chronic kidney disease, not a synonym for all CKD.

Chronic Lead Poisoning

Illness caused by long-term or repeated exposure to lead. It may cause abdominal pain, constipation, tiredness, anemia, nerve damage, high blood pressure, or kidney injury. In children, it can impair learning, attention, growth, or development. Treatment begins with stopping the exposure; some people need specialist-directed chelation.

Chronic Leukemia

A blood cancer that develops gradually as abnormal white blood cells multiply and remain in the blood or bone marrow. Some types progress slowly but still require regular medical monitoring.

Chronic Limb-Threatening Ischemia

Severe, long-lasting reduction of blood flow to a limb, usually from narrowed or blocked arteries. It causes pain at rest, ulcers that do not heal, or gangrene and can lead to limb loss.

Chronic Liver Disease

A broad term for long-term liver damage or disease. Causes include viral infection, alcohol, fatty-liver disease, autoimmune disease, blocked bile flow, medicines, and inherited disorders. It may occur with or without cirrhosis; progressive scarring can lead to cirrhosis or liver failure.

Chronic Liver Failure

Long-term loss of the liver's ability to perform essential functions such as protein synthesis, detoxification, bile processing, and metabolic regulation. It may result from advanced cirrhosis or other chronic liver diseases and can lead to jaundice, ascites, bleeding tendency, hepatic encephalopathy, portal hypertension, and other organ complications.

Chronic Low Back Pain

Persistent or recurring pain in the lumbar or lumbosacral region lasting longer than 12 weeks. Multifactorial etiologies include degenerative disc disease, lumbar spinal stenosis, spondylosis, facet arthropathy, and central pain sensitization.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Lumbago; Long-Term Back Pain

Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia

A usually slow-growing blood cancer in which abnormal B lymphocytes build up in the blood, bone marrow, and lymph nodes. It may cause enlarged lymph nodes, tiredness, repeated infections, anaemia, or no symptoms at first.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Lymphoid Leukemia

Chronic Lymphocytic Thyroiditis

An autoimmune disease in which immune attack gradually damages the thyroid, often causing hypothyroidism, fatigue, cold intolerance, constipation, dry skin, or goiter.

Chronic Megacolon

Persistent abnormal enlargement and impaired propulsion of the colon. Causes include severe constipation, aganglionosis, neurologic disease, metabolic disorders, medications, or chronic intestinal obstruction.

Chronic Meningitis

Persistent inflammation of the membranes around the brain and spinal cord, usually lasting four weeks or longer. Causes include tuberculosis, fungal or other infections, cancer, autoimmune disease, and medication reactions; symptoms may develop gradually or fluctuate.

Chronic Mesenteric Ischemia

A condition caused by long-standing narrowing of the arteries supplying the gastrointestinal tract, most commonly from atherosclerosis of the celiac axis and mesenteric arteries. It typically causes dull, cramping abdominal pain 30 to 60 minutes after meals (intestinal angina), resulting in fear of eating (sitophobia) and significant unintentional weight loss.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Mesenteric Ischaemia; Intestinal Angina; Abdominal Angina; CMI

Chronic Migraine

Headache on at least 15 days each month for more than three months, with migraine features on at least eight days. Pain may be one-sided or throbbing and may include nausea or sensitivity to light or sound.

Chronic Mitral Regurgitation

Long-standing leakage through the mitral valve during left-ventricular contraction. It may be primary, such as from prolapse, rheumatic disease, or endocarditis, or secondary to left-ventricular enlargement or ischemia; chronic volume overload can enlarge the left atrium and ventricle and lead to atrial fibrillation, pulmonary hypertension, or heart failure.

Chronic Motor Or Vocal Tic Disorder

A neurodevelopmental disorder with persistent motor or vocal tics lasting more than one year; symptoms often fluctuate and may be treated with education, behavioral therapy, or medicines when impairment is significant.

Chronic Mucocutaneous Candidiasis

Persistent or recurrent *Candida* infections of the skin, nails, and mucous membranes, often beginning in childhood. It may reflect a specific inherited T-cell or IL-17 pathway defect, or occur with autoimmune or endocrine disease.

Chronic Myelogenous Leukemia

A blood cancer in which the bone marrow makes too many abnormal white blood cells, usually because of the BCR::ABL1 gene change. It may progress over time but is often controlled with targeted medicines.

Chronic Myeloid Leukemia

A blood cancer usually caused by the Philadelphia chromosome, which creates the BCR::ABL1 gene. The bone marrow produces too many abnormal

white blood cells, and targeted treatment can often control the disease.

Chronic Myelomonocytic Leukemia

A rare blood cancer in which the bone marrow makes too many monocytes, a type of white blood cell, along with abnormal blood-forming cells. It can cause anemia, infections, bleeding, fatigue, or an enlarged spleen.

Chronic Neutrophilic Leukaemia

A rare blood cancer in which the bone marrow continually makes too many mature neutrophils, a type of white blood cell, without infection being the main cause. It may cause tiredness, fever, weight loss, or an enlarged spleen.

Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease

A progressive, long-term lung disease that causes chronic airflow obstruction and breathing difficulty. Primarily caused by long-term exposure to irritating gases or particles—most commonly cigarette smoke—it encompasses two main overlapping conditions: extbfchronic bronchitis (long-standing inflammation and excessive mucus in the airways) and extbfemphysema (gradual destruction of the tiny air sacs in the lungs). Typical symptoms include persistent cough, excess phlegm, wheezing, and shortness of breath.

Chronic Otitis Media

Long-lasting or repeated inflammation or infection in the space behind the eardrum. It may cause fluid or ongoing discharge, hearing loss, or changes to the eardrum and small bones in the ear. In some cases, it can lead to a cholesteatoma.

Chronic Pharyngitis

Long-lasting or repeated soreness and inflammation of the throat. It may be linked to smoke or other irritants, dry air, allergies, mucus dripping from the nose, or stomach contents coming up into the throat.

Chronic Pain

Pain that persists or recurs for longer than three months. It may have an identifiable ongoing cause or persist after healing, and is influenced by complex interactions among biological, psychological, and social factors.

Chronic Pain Syndrome

Long-lasting pain accompanied by substantial effects on movement, sleep, mood, relationships, or daily activities. Treatment addresses pain and these related effects rather than relying only on pain medicines.

Chronic Pancreatitis

Repeated or long-term inflammation that permanently scars the pancreas. It may cause upper-abdominal pain, poor digestion, weight loss, diabetes, or oily stools; alcohol, smoking, inherited disorders, and blocked ducts are possible causes.

Chronic Paroxysmal Hemicrania

A primary headache disorder causing frequent, short-lasting, severe one-sided headaches with autonomic symptoms and a characteristic response to indomethacin.

Alternate Names:
CPH; Chronic Paroxysmal Hemicrania Syndrome

Chronic Pelvic Pain

Pain in the pelvic area that lasts for six months or longer. It may be constant or come and go, and may be related to reproductive, urinary, digestive, muscle, nerve, or pain-processing conditions. Sometimes more than one cause is present, or no single cause can be found.

Chronic Pelvic Pain in Women

Pain in the pelvis lasting or recurring for months and affecting daily life, sexual activity, urination, bowel function, or mood. Causes may include endometriosis, pelvic floor disorders, bladder or bowel disease, adhesions, neuropathic pain, or no single identifiable cause.

Chronic Pelvic Pain Syndrome

Persistent or recurring pain in the pelvis, area between the genitals and anus, lower abdomen, back, or scrotum without a proven ongoing bacterial infec-

tion. Urinary symptoms, painful ejaculation, muscle tension, and sexual problems may also occur.

Alternate Names:
CPPS; NIH Category III Prostatitis; Chronic Non-bacterial Prostatitis

Chronic Progressive External Ophthalmoplegia

A slowly worsening muscle disorder causing drooping eyelids and limited movement of both eyes. It often begins in adulthood and may occur alone or with weakness of other muscles; inherited mitochondrial disease is a common cause.

Alternate Names:
CPEO; Progressive External Ophthalmoplegia (PEO)

Chronic Pyelonephritis

Long-term inflammation and scarring of the kidneys, often after repeated infections or backward flow of urine. It can gradually reduce kidney function and may cause high blood pressure, poor growth, or kidney failure.

Chronic Recurrent Multifocal Osteomyelitis

A rare autoinflammatory bone disorder, often beginning in children or adolescents, causing recurrent sterile inflammation and pain at multiple bone sites.

Alternate Names:
CRMO

Chronic Rejection

Progressive immune-mediated injury to a transplanted organ or tissue, often developing over months or years. Persistent antibody- or T-cell-mediated responses damage graft tissue and vessels, causing fibrosis, vascular narrowing, and gradual loss of function. The pattern varies by organ.

Chronic Renal Failure

Older term for kidney failure lasting more than three months. It refers to advanced chronic kidney disease, not to all chronic kidney disease; current terminology favors *Chronic Kidney Failure* or specifies kidney failure and its duration.

Chronic Respiratory Failure

Persistent failure of the respiratory system to maintain adequate oxygenation, carbon-dioxide removal, or both. It may result from lung disease, neuromuscular weakness, chest-wall disorders, or other conditions; it may be hypoxemic, hypercapnic, or both.

Alternate Names:
Long-Term Respiratory Insufficiency

Chronic Rhinitis

Long-lasting inflammation or irritation of the nose causing congestion, runny nose, sneezing, itching, or mucus draining into the throat. Causes include allergy, irritants, medicines, and structural problems; management depends on the cause.

Alternate Names:
Persistent Rhinitis

Chronic Rhinosinusitis

Inflammation of the nasal lining and paranasal sinuses lasting at least 12 weeks, with symptoms such as nasal obstruction, discharge, facial pressure, or reduced smell. Diagnosis also requires objective evidence of inflammation on examination, nasal endoscopy, or imaging; the condition may occur with or without nasal polyps.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Sinusitis; CRS

Chronic Rhinosinusitis With Nasal Polyps

Long-lasting inflammation of the nose and sinuses with soft, swollen growths called nasal polyps. It can cause blocked breathing through the nose, drainage, reduced smell, facial pressure, or recurrent sinus symptoms.

Chronic Sinusitis

Alternate name; see *Chronic Rhinosinusitis*.

Chronic Spontaneous Urticaria

Recurrent itchy wheals, angioedema, or both for six weeks or longer without a consistent external trigger. It has heterogeneous mechanisms; autoim-

mune or autoallergic mechanisms are present in some patients but do not explain every case.

Alternate Names:
CSU; Chronic Idiopathic Urticaria

Chronic Stiff Neck

Persistent reduced movement or tightness in the neck. Muscle strain, arthritis, disc disease, inflammation, or nerve problems may be responsible; fever, injury, weakness, numbness, or severe headache may indicate another underlying condition.

Chronic Subdural Hematoma

A collection of blood and breakdown products between the dura and arachnoid that develops over weeks, often after minor trauma in older adults, causing headache, confusion, weakness, or gait change.

Chronic Suppurative Otitis Media

Persistent inflammation and infection of the middle ear with recurrent or continuous ear discharge, usually through a perforated tympanic membrane. It can cause conductive hearing loss and may lead to cholesteatoma or other complications.

Alternate Names:
CSOM; Chronic Otitis Media with Discharge; Chronic Suppurative Middle-Ear Infection

Chronic Tension-Type Headache

A primary headache occurring on at least 15 days per month for more than three months. It is usually bilateral, pressing or tightening, and mild to moderate, without worsening during routine activity. Marked nausea or vomiting is absent; headache caused by a structural brain disorder is classified as secondary, not tension-type headache.

Chronic Thromboembolic Pulmonary Hypertension

Pulmonary hypertension caused by persistent organized clot and scar-like obstruction in the pulmonary arteries, usually after pulmonary embolism. A recognized acute embolism is not required; some people have no known history of one. The condition can strain the right side of the heart.

Chronic Toxicity

Harm caused by repeated or long-term exposure to a substance, even when each individual dose is small. Damage may build up over time and affect organs such as the brain, liver, kidneys, lungs, or nerves.

Chronic Traumatic Encephalopathy

A brain disorder associated with repeated blows or jolts to the head over time. It may be linked with later changes in memory, thinking, mood, behavior, or movement; diagnosis cannot be confirmed during life by a single test.

Chronic Urticaria

Repeated itchy raised welts, swelling, or both that last or recur for six weeks or longer. It may occur without a clear trigger or be brought on by factors such as cold, heat, or pressure. Each welt usually fades within a day without leaving a scar.

Chronic Venous Disease

Long-term difficulty returning blood from the legs to the heart because veins leak, are blocked, or do not receive enough help from leg muscles. It can cause varicose veins, swelling, skin changes, and ulcers.

Chronic Venous Insufficiency

Poor return of blood from the legs because the vein valves do not close properly or the veins are blocked. It can cause swelling, aching, varicose veins, dark or hardened skin, and ulcers near the ankle.

Chronic Venous Stasis

Persistent pooling of blood in the lower limbs caused by impaired venous return. It can produce edema, skin discoloration, dermatitis, and venous ulcers.

Chronic Villitis

Inflammation of the chorionic villi, the branching placental structures that exchange oxygen and nutrients between maternal and fetal blood. It is identified by microscopic examination of the placenta and may be caused by infection or occur without an identified infection, as in villitis of unknown etiology.

It is associated with placental dysfunction and fetal growth restriction, although the significance varies with its extent and cause.

Chronic Vulvar Pain

Alternate index label; see *Vulvodynia*.

Chronobiology

Chronobiology studies biological timing and rhythms, including circadian sleep-wake cycles, seasonal rhythms, and their effects on health.

Chronotropic

Chronotropic describes an influence on heart rate; a positive chronotropic effect increases rate, while a negative effect decreases it.

Churg-Strauss Disease

Former name; see *Eosinophilic Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis*.

Churg-Strauss Syndrome

A rare disease in which inflamed small and medium blood vessels are associated with asthma and too many eosinophils, a type of white blood cell. It can damage the lungs, nerves, skin, heart, or kidneys.

Alternate Names:
EGPA; Eosinophilic Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis

Chvostek Sign

Twitching of facial muscles after tapping over the facial nerve near the ear. It can occur with low blood calcium but is not reliable enough by itself to diagnose that condition.

Chvostek's Sign

Chvostek's sign is twitching of facial muscles after tapping near the facial nerve, sometimes associated with hypocalcemia but neither sensitive nor specific.

Chylangioma

Alternate name; see *Lymphangioma*.

Chyle

A milky fluid formed in intestinal lymph vessels after a meal. It contains lymph and absorbed dietary fat and normally travels through the thoracic duct into the bloodstream.

Chylomicron

A particle made by the intestine after eating fat. It carries dietary fat and cholesterol through the lymph and blood, then leaves remnants for the liver to remove.

Chylomicronemia Syndrome

Severe elevation of triglyceride-rich chylomicrons in blood, usually from genetic or acquired impairment of triglyceride clearance; it can cause abdominal pain, eruptive xanthomas, and recurrent acute pancreatitis.

Chylothorax

A buildup of chyle in the space around a lung, usually after injury or blockage of the thoracic duct. It can cause breathlessness; management may involve drainage, dietary measures, or surgery to address the leak.

Chylous Ascites

Accumulation of lymphatic fluid rich in triglycerides within the abdominal cavity. It can result from lymphatic obstruction, malignancy, trauma, surgery, infection, or congenital disease and may cause abdominal distention, malnutrition, or immune-cell loss.

Chyluria

Passage of lymphatic fluid into the urine, giving it a milky appearance. It usually results from an abnormal communication between lymphatic vessels and the urinary tract.

Chyme

A semifluid mixture of partially digested food and gastric or intestinal secretions that passes from the stomach into the small intestine.

Alternate Names:

Digestive Chyme; Gastric Chyme

Chymotrypsin

Chymotrypsin is a pancreatic digestive enzyme that cleaves proteins in the small intestine; abnormal pancreatic release can contribute to tissue injury.

CIC

Commonly, clean intermittent catheterization: periodic insertion of a catheter to empty the bladder, followed by removal; other expansions are possible by context.

Cicatricial Alopecia

Hair loss caused by destruction and scarring of hair follicles, usually leading to permanent loss in affected areas.

Alternate Names:
Scarring Alopecia; Cicatricial Hair Loss

Cicatrization

Cicatrization is healing by formation of a scar after tissue injury, with replacement of damaged tissue by fibrous connective tissue.

Ciclopia

A rare severe congenital malformation in which the eyes are fused or a single median eye develops, usually as part of holoprosencephaly.

CICO Emergency

A life-threatening airway emergency in which a breathing tube cannot be placed and enough oxygen cannot be delivered by mask or another airway device. Management may involve an emergency surgical airway.

Alternate Names:
Cannot Intubate, Cannot Oxygenate; CICO; Failed Airway Crisis; Emergency Front-of-Neck Airway Scenario

Cidofovir

Cidofovir is an antiviral nucleotide analogue used for selected serious DNA-virus infections; kidney toxicity requires careful dosing and monitoring.

CIDP

Chronic inflammatory demyelinating polyneuropathy is a chronic, immune-mediated, peripheral neuropathy characterized by progressive or relapsing symmetrical weakness and sensory loss in all four limbs, with areflexia or hyporeflexia, lasting for more than eight weeks.

Cigarette

A small cylinder of tobacco or other material wrapped in paper for smoking; smoke exposure delivers nicotine and many toxic and carcinogenic substances.

Cigarette Smoking

Alternate form; see *Smoking*.

Ciguatera

Food poisoning caused by eating reef fish containing ciguatoxins. It may cause gastrointestinal illness followed by neurologic symptoms such as paresthesias and temperature-sensation disturbance.

Ciguatera Poisoning

Ciguatera poisoning follows eating reef fish containing ciguatoxins. Gastrointestinal symptoms may be followed by neurologic sensations such as temperature reversal, tingling, itching, weakness, or abnormal heart rate; no reliably proven antidote exists.

Alternate Names:
Ciguatera Fish Poisoning (CFP); Ciguatoxicity

Ciguatera Toxicity

Food poisoning from ciguatoxins in contaminated reef fish. It typically causes early nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, and abdominal pain followed by perioral or distal paresthesias, itching, weakness, and temperature reversal; bradycardia or hypotension can occur. No reliably proven antidote exists.

Ciguatera Toxin

Alternate name; see *Ciguatoxin*.

Ciguatoxin

A heat-stable toxin produced by marine microorganisms and accumulated in some reef fish, causing ciguatera poisoning with gastrointestinal, neurologic, and temperature-sensation symptoms.

Cilia

Tiny hair-like structures on cells that move fluid, mucus, or particles across a tissue surface. In the airways, they help clear inhaled material; some cilia also sense signals and help move an egg cell.

Ciliary Body

A ring-shaped part of the eye between the iris and choroid. Its muscle changes the lens shape for focusing, and its processes make the fluid that fills the front of the eye.

Ciliary Body Melanoma

A melanoma arising in the uveal tract behind the iris. It may be asymptomatic or cause blurred vision, floaters, pain, or a visible change in the pupil or iris; ophthalmic examination and imaging guide diagnosis and eye-preserving or surgical treatment.

Ciliary Dyskinesia

Abnormal movement of cilia that impairs clearance of mucus from the airways and can cause recurrent respiratory infections.

Ciliary Flush

A violaceous, ring-like injection of deep episcleral vessels encircling the corneal limbus, serving as a cardinal physical sign of active intraocular inflammation such as iritis, keratitis, or acute angle-closure glaucoma.

Alternate Names:
Perilimbal Injection; Ciliary Injection

Ciliary Muscle

A ring of smooth muscle in the eye that changes the lens shape for focusing at different distances and helps regulate aqueous humor outflow through ciliary-body structures.

Ciliary Neuralgia

Pain arising from or felt along the ciliary nerves around the eye, often described as deep orbital or eye pain; causes vary.

Ciliated

Bearing cilia, tiny hair-like cell projections that move material across a tissue surface. Ciliated cells line parts of the respiratory and reproductive tracts; impaired ciliary function can disrupt mucus clearance or transport.

Ciliopathy

A disorder caused by abnormal cell cilia, the tiny structures that move material or sense signals. It may affect development, vision, kidney function, breathing, or several organs.

Cimetidine

Cimetidine is an H2-receptor antagonist that reduces gastric acid secretion; it has numerous drug interactions and is used less often than newer agents.

Cinacalcet

A calcimimetic drug that activates calcium-sensing receptors and lowers parathyroid hormone, used for selected forms of hyperparathyroidism and hypercalcemia.

Cineangiocardiography

Radiographic recording of the heart and blood vessels during passage of contrast material, used to visualize cardiac chambers, valves, and coronary or great vessels.

Cineangiography

Motion-picture X-ray imaging of the heart or blood vessels while contrast material passes through them, used to show blood flow and moving cardiac structures.

Cinefluorography

Motion-picture recording of fluoroscopic images, used to document movement of organs or contrast material during a diagnostic examination.

Cineplasty

Surgical creation of a muscle-controlled stump or related reconstruction, historically used to improve control of a prosthetic limb.

Cingulotomy

A brain operation that interrupts selected nerve fibers involved in emotion and pain processing. It is reserved for rare, severe conditions that have not improved with other treatments and can cause bleeding, seizures, personality changes, or other brain injury.

Cinnarizine

Cinnarizine is an antihistamine with calcium-channel-blocking properties used in some countries for motion sickness and vestibular symptoms.

Ciprofloxacin

Ciprofloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections; tendon injury, nerve effects, QT effects, and resistance limit indiscriminate use.

Circadian Rhythm

An endogenous, self-sustaining biological oscillation with a period of approximately 24 hours that governs cellular metabolism, sleep-wake cycles, body temperature, autonomic tone, and endocrine secretion (such as the nocturnal surge of melatonin and the early-morning awakening surge of cortisol). Synchronized to the 24-hour solar cycle by environmental zeitgebers, primarily photic input received by intrinsically photosensitive retinal ganglion cells (ipRGCs) expressing melanopsin, which transmit signals along the retinohypothalamic tract to the master pacemaker in the suprachiasmatic nucleus (SCN) of the anterior hypothalamus. Molecular regulation is driven by an intracellular autoregulatory transcription-translation feedback loop involving *CLOCK*, *BMAL1*, *PER*, and *CRY* genes.

Circadian Rhythms

Plural form; see *Circadian Rhythm*.

Circadian Rhythm Sleep Disorder

A family of sleep disturbances arising from a persistent misalignment between an individual's endogenous biological circadian rhythm and external societal light-dark cycles, including delayed sleep phase disorder, advanced sleep phase disorder, shift-work disorder, and jet lag.

Circle of Willis

A ring-shaped network of arteries at the base of the brain that connects the front and back blood supplies. It may provide an alternate route for blood if an artery narrows or becomes blocked, but its structure varies and it may not provide enough backup flow.

Circulating Tumor Cell

A cancer cell that has detached from a tumor and entered the bloodstream. Testing may help study cancer spread or treatment response, but clinical use depends on the specific validated test and cancer.

Circulating Tumor DNA

Small fragments of DNA released by cancer cells into the blood. Testing them may help identify tumour changes, monitor treatment, or detect remaining disease, but it does not replace tissue diagnosis in every situation.

Circulation

Continuous movement of blood through the heart and blood vessels, or of lymph through lymphatic vessels, to transport oxygen, nutrients, hormones, and waste.

Circulatory

Relating to the movement of blood or lymph and to the organs and vessels that carry them.

Circulatory System

The heart and blood-vessel network that pumps and distributes blood through pulmonary and systemic circuits; broadly, the term may include the lymphatic system.

Circumcision

Surgical removal of the foreskin covering the head of the penis. It may be performed for cultural, religious, preventive, or medical reasons; possible complications include bleeding, infection, pain, and injury, although serious problems are uncommon with proper care.

Circumduction

A compound, sequential circular joint movement combining flexion, abduction, extension, and adduction such that the distal end of an extremity moves in a circle while the proximal shaft delineates a cone, seen at ball-and-socket joints such as the shoulder and hip.

Circumflex

Curving around; the circumflex coronary artery is a branch of the left coronary artery that travels around the heart's lateral and posterior surface.

Circumflex Artery

A branch of the left coronary artery that runs around the left side and back of the heart. It supplies blood to the left atrium and much of the outer and back wall of the left ventricle.

Circumvallate Papillae

Circumvallate papillae are large taste papillae arranged near the back of the tongue and surrounded by a trench containing taste buds and serous glands.

Circumvallate Placenta

An extrachorial placental configuration in which the chorionic plate is smaller than the basal plate, producing a raised circumferential edge; it may be associated with bleeding, abruption, or growth restriction.

Cirrhosis

Advanced liver scarring in which fibrous bands and regenerating nodules distort the liver's structure and blood flow. It usually develops after long-term liver injury, such as from chronic hepatitis, alcohol-associated liver disease, or metabolic or autoimmune disease, and can cause portal hypertension and reduced liver function. Cirrhosis may remain compensated without major symptoms or become decompensated, causing complications such as abdominal fluid buildup, variceal bleeding, or hepatic encephalopathy; it also increases the risk of liver cancer.

Cirrhosis Of The Liver

Alternate name; see *Cirrhosis*.

Cisplatin

A platinum-based chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used to treat several cancers; important toxicities include kidney injury, hearing loss, neuropathy, and nausea.

Cisterna Chyli

A widened, sac-like part of the lymphatic system in the upper abdomen. It receives lymph from the lower body and intestines and continues upward as the thoracic duct.

Cisterna Magna

The largest subarachnoid cistern, located in the posterior cranial fossa between the inferior surface of the cerebellum and the dorsal aspect of the medulla oblongata, which receives cerebrospinal fluid directly from the fourth ventricle via the median aperture (foramen of Magendie).

Alternate Names:
Cerebellomedullary Cistern

Citalopram

Citalopram is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor used to treat depression and some anxiety disorders; nausea, sexual effects, and QT prolongation are important considerations.

Citrate

Citrate is a salt or ion of citric acid that participates in metabolism and binds calcium; it is used in anticoagulant blood collection and some stone-prevention treatments.

Citrate Synthase

An enzyme that begins an important energy-producing process inside cells. It joins acetyl-CoA with oxaloacetate to make citrate, the first step of the citric acid cycle, which helps release energy from food.

Citric Acid Cycle

A series of chemical reactions inside mitochondria, the cell's energy-making structures, that breaks down food-derived molecules and produces energy. It also makes substances needed to build proteins, fats, and other cell components.

Citric Acid Urine Test

A urine test measuring citrate excretion, used mainly in the evaluation of recurrent kidney stones because low urinary citrate increases the risk of calcium stone formation.

Citrullinaemia

An inherited disorder of the urea cycle causing citrulline and ammonia buildup, which can lead to vomiting, confusion, seizures, coma, or death.

Citrullinemia

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly remove nitrogen through the urea cycle. Citrulline and ammonia build up, causing vomiting, poor feeding, sleepiness, confusion, seizures, coma, or death.

CJD

Alternate name; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease*.

CK

Creatine kinase, an enzyme found in skeletal muscle, heart muscle, and brain whose blood level may rise after tissue injury.

Alternate Names:
Creatine Phosphokinase; Creatine Kinase Enzyme

CKD-Mineral Bone Disorder

A complication of chronic kidney disease in which abnormal calcium, phosphate, vitamin D, and parathyroid hormone levels weaken bones and may cause calcium deposits in blood vessels and other tissues.

Cladribine

Cladribine is a purine analogue used for selected blood cancers and multiple sclerosis; lymphocyte depletion and infection risk require monitoring.

Clagett Procedure

A staged surgical procedure for chronic pleural empyema with bronchopleural fistula, consisting of open thoracic fenestration (open window thoracostomy) to drain the pleural space, followed by sequential cavity debridement, antibiotic irrigation, and eventual secondary chest wall closure.

Alternate Names:
Open Window Thoracostomy Closure; Clagett Window

Clammy Skin

Skin that feels cool, damp, or unusually sweaty. It may occur with heat, anxiety, pain, low blood sugar, shock, or other illness.

Clamp

A surgical instrument used to grasp, compress, occlude, or hold tissue, blood vessels, tubing, or other structures.

Clang Association

Clang association is speech in which word choice is driven by sound, rhyme, or pun rather than meaning, seen particularly in mania or psychosis.

Clarithromycin

Clarithromycin is a macrolide antibiotic used for selected bacterial and mycobacterial infections; interactions and QT prolongation are important risks.

Clark Level Of Invasion

An older system describing how deeply a melanoma has grown through the skin layers. Modern melanoma assessment relies more on tumor thickness, ulceration, spread, and other features.

Class IA Antiarrhythmics

Heart-rhythm medicines that slow electrical conduction and lengthen the time heart cells need before they can fire again. They treat selected abnormal rhythms but can themselves cause dangerous rhythm disturbances.

Class IB Antiarrhythmics

Heart-rhythm medicines that reduce abnormal electrical activity, especially in injured heart muscle. They are used mainly for selected fast rhythms arising from the lower chambers and require monitoring.

Class IC Antiarrhythmics

Strong heart-rhythm medicines that slow electrical conduction without greatly changing recovery time. They can treat selected upper-chamber rhythms but may be dangerous in people with structural heart disease.

Classic Galactosemia

A serious inherited disorder caused by severe deficiency of galactose-1-phosphate uridyltransferase. Milk feeding can rapidly cause jaundice, liver dysfunction, hypoglycemia, infection, and neurologic injury; lifelong galactose restriction is required.

Classic Migraine

A migraine attack preceded or accompanied by an aura, such as temporary visual, sensory, or speech changes. Headache may follow, with nausea and light or sound sensitivity, although patterns vary.

Classic Type Pfeiffer Syndrome

A genetic craniosynostosis syndrome, usually related to an *FGFR2* variant, causing early fusion of skull sutures, broad or deviated thumbs and great toes, and variable facial, airway, neurologic, or developmental problems.

Class III Antiarrhythmics

Heart-rhythm medicines that lengthen the recovery period between electrical beats. They treat selected abnormal rhythms but may slow the heart, affect organs, or prolong the electrical interval and cause dangerous rhythms.

Clathrin

A major polymeric coat protein composed of three heavy and three light chains forming a three-legged triskelion, which self-assembles into a polyhedral basket-like lattice that coats and internalizes endocytic vesicles during receptor-mediated endocytosis.

Claude Syndrome

A brainstem stroke syndrome caused by an ischemic or hemorrhagic infarction of the dorsal midbrain tegmentum affecting the oculomotor nerve fascicles, red nucleus, and cerebellothalamic tract. Clinical features include ipsilateral third cranial nerve palsy (ptosis, dilated pupil, and ophthalmoplegia) and contralateral cerebellar ataxia, tremor, and dysmetria.

Alternate Names:
Claude's Syndrome; Inferior Rubro-Spinal Syndrome

Claudication

Pain, aching, cramping, or weakness in a limb brought on by walking or other exertion. Vascular claudication, usually caused by reduced arterial blood flow, improves with rest; neurogenic claudication, often caused by lumbar spinal stenosis, typically improves with sitting or leaning forward.

Claudication Distance

The distance a person can walk before exertional limb pain begins. It is used to describe symptoms and monitor change.

Claustrophobia

An intense fear of enclosed or confined spaces that may cause anxiety, panic, or avoidance. Symptoms can occur in places such as elevators, tunnels, or MRI scanners.

Clavicle

The collarbone, a curved bone running from the breastbone to the shoulder blade. It supports the shoulder and commonly breaks after a fall or direct blow, causing pain, swelling, or visible deformity.

Clavicle Fracture

A break in the collarbone that may occur during birth or after trauma. A newborn may show asymmetric arm movement or tenderness; older children and adults may have pain, swelling, or deformity. Diagnosis is usually made by examination and imaging.

Clavus

A clavus is a localized painful thickening of skin, or corn, caused by repeated pressure or friction.

Claw Foot

A shape of the toes in which they bend upward where they join the foot and downward at the middle and tips. It can develop when foot muscles are unbalanced, after nerve damage, with arthritis, or from shoes that do not fit well.

Claw Hand

A deformity in which the large finger joints bend backward while the smaller joints bend inward. It is commonly caused by ulnar-nerve damage and may impair grip and hand function.

Claw Toe

A toe deformity characterized by extension at the metatarsophalangeal joint and flexion at the proximal and distal interphalangeal joints.

Clay-Colored Stool

Pale, gray, or white stool caused by reduced bile reaching the intestine. It can occur with bile-duct obstruction, liver disease, or pancreatic disease, especially when accompanied by jaundice or dark urine.

Alternate Names:
Acholic Stool; Pale Stool

Clean-Catch Specimen

A urine sample collected after cleansing the surrounding area and beginning urination, with the middle portion collected in a sterile container to reduce contamination.

Clean Catch Urine Sample

A midstream urine specimen collected after cleaning the genital area to reduce contamination and improve interpretation of urinalysis or culture.

Cleaning Supplies And Equipment

Materials and devices used to remove soil and microorganisms from surfaces or equipment; selection and disinfection level depend on the item and infection risk.

Clearance

The rate at which the body removes a medicine or other substance from the blood. The liver, kidneys, and sometimes other organs contribute; clearance helps determine how much medicine is needed and how often it should be given.

Clear Cell Carcinoma

Clear cell carcinoma is a cancer whose cells appear clear because of glycogen or lipid; it can arise in organs such as kidney, ovary, or endometrium.

Clear Cell Carcinoma Of The Ovary

A type of ovarian cancer whose cells look clear under a microscope. It is often associated with endometriosis and may be found at an earlier stage, but can resist some standard treatments and increase the risk of blood clots; treatment depends on stage and overall health.

Clear Cell Renal Cell Carcinoma

The most common type of kidney cancer in adults. The cancer cells look clear under a microscope because they contain stored fat and sugar; it may cause blood in the urine, pain, or a mass, but early disease may cause no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
CcRCC; Conventional Renal Cell Carcinoma

Clear Cell Renal Cell Carcinoma Pathology

A renal carcinoma composed of clear cells containing lipid and glycogen, commonly arranged in nests or sheets separated by a delicate branching vascula-

ture. Diagnosis and grading depend on architecture, cytology, necrosis, and invasion.

Clear Liquid Diet

A limited diet consisting of transparent liquids such as water, clear broth, apple juice, and black coffee that leave minimal residue. It is used for short periods before procedures, during acute illness, or after surgery to maintain hydration while resting the gastrointestinal tract.

Clear Margins

A laboratory finding that no abnormal or cancer cells are seen at the edge of tissue removed during a procedure. It suggests the abnormal area may have been completely removed, but it does not by itself rule out disease elsewhere.

Cleft Lip

A birth defect in which the upper lip does not join completely before birth. The opening may be small or extend toward the nose and may occur alone or with a cleft palate, affecting feeding, teeth, or speech.

Cleft Lip And Cleft Palate

Congenital openings in the upper lip, the palate, or both, caused when developing facial tissues do not join completely. A cleft lip may occur alone or with a cleft palate; a cleft palate may also occur alone. The extent varies, and these conditions may affect feeding, speech, hearing, or tooth development.

Alternate Names:
Cleft Lip And Palate

Cleft Lip And Palate Repair

Surgery to close a cleft in the lip, palate, or both and improve feeding, speech, hearing, breathing, or appearance. Repair is usually staged during childhood and requires long-term dental and specialist follow-up.

Cleft Palate

A birth defect in which there is an opening in the roof of the mouth. It may occur alone or with a cleft lip and can cause problems with feeding, speech, hearing, or teeth.

Cleidocranial Dysostosis

An inherited bone disorder, usually caused by a RUNX2 gene change, in which the collarbones may be small or absent and skull bones close late. Extra teeth, delayed tooth eruption, short stature, and joint problems are common.

Cleidocranial Dysplasia

An inherited disorder of bone development affecting the collarbones and skull. It can cause delayed closure of skull joints, unusual teeth, short stature, and other skeletal differences.

Clemastine

Clemastine is a first-generation antihistamine used for allergic symptoms; sedation, anticholinergic effects, and impaired driving are concerns.

Click-Murmur Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Mitral Valve Prolapse*.

Climacteric

The period of physiologic change around the end of reproductive capacity, including the menopausal transition. It may involve changes in menstruation, vasomotor symptoms, and other endocrine effects.

Climate Change

Long-term changes in temperature, precipitation, and weather patterns, largely driven by human-produced greenhouse gases. Health effects include heat illness, worsened air quality, infectious-disease changes, injuries, and effects on food, water, and mental health.

Clindamycin

Clindamycin is a lincosamide antibiotic used for selected infections; diarrhea and Clostridioides difficile colitis are important adverse effects.

Clinical

Relating to direct observation, examination, diagnosis, or treatment of a patient, rather than solely

to laboratory or basic research findings.

Clinical Biology

A field of laboratory medicine that analyzes patient samples using biological, biochemical, and molecular tests to diagnose or monitor disease. In some health systems, it is the broad name for diagnostic laboratory specialties; the exact scope differs by country.

Clinical Chemistry

The laboratory discipline that applies chemical and biochemical methods to measure substances or activities in patient specimens. It analyzes blood, urine, and other body fluids for electrolytes, glucose, lipids, enzymes, hormones, and drug levels, providing data used to assess health and disease.

Alternate Names:
Clinical Biochemistry

Clinical Communication

Exchange of information between healthcare professionals, patients, and caregivers to support diagnosis, treatment, safety, and informed decisions.

Clinical Counseling

Guidance provided in healthcare to help patients make informed decisions about health, prevention, treatment, and self-management.

Clinical Depression

A depressive illness causing persistent sadness or loss of interest, together with changes in sleep, appetite, energy, thinking, or self-worth that significantly interfere with daily life.

Clinical Deterioration

Worsening health that increases the risk of organ failure, disability, or death. Warning signs may include new confusion, breathing difficulty, abnormal vital signs, reduced urine, worsening pain, or poor circulation.

Clinical Diagnostics

The use of history, examination, laboratory tests, imaging, pathology, and other methods to identify or evaluate a health condition and guide care.

Clinical Disease

Disease that produces recognizable signs or symptoms or other findings detectable in a patient, as opposed to a silent or subclinical state.

Clinical Frailty Scale

A scale used by a healthcare professional to describe how fit, independent, or frail an older person is. It considers activity, daily function, and illness burden and supports care planning.

Clinical Handover

The transfer of responsibility for a patient's care from one healthcare professional or team to another. A safe handover states the diagnosis, current condition, risks, pending tasks, and what to do if the patient worsens.

Clinical Imaging

Medical imaging used to visualize anatomy, physiology, or disease, including radiography, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and nuclear medicine.

Clinical Microbiology

The laboratory discipline that detects and identifies bacteria, viruses, fungi, and parasites in patient specimens. It may also test antimicrobial susceptibility and help distinguish infection from colonization or contamination.

Clinical Neurophysiology

The diagnostic medical discipline that assesses and monitors function of the central, peripheral, and autonomic nervous systems and skeletal muscles, mainly through electrophysiologic testing. Methods include electroencephalography, electromyography, nerve-conduction studies, evoked potentials, and intraoperative monitoring. Results help localize and characterize neurologic and neuromuscular disorders.

Clinical Nutrition

The use of nutrition science to prevent, identify, and manage health problems. It includes assessment of food intake and nutritional status, dietary treatment, and nutrition support when ordinary eating is not enough or is unsafe.

Clinical Pharmacology

The medical science of medicines and their effects in people. It includes how medicines work, how the body absorbs and removes them, how they are used, and how their benefits, interactions, and risks are assessed.

Clinical Presentation

The symptoms, signs, examination findings, and test results seen in a person with a health problem. The presentation can differ with the cause, severity, age, other illnesses, and the time since the problem began.

Clinical Psychologist

A licensed mental-health professional who assesses and treats psychological, emotional, behavioral, and cognitive problems using psychotherapy and other evidence-based interventions within local scope of practice.

Clinical Reasoning

The process healthcare professionals use to combine a person's symptoms, examination, test results, history, and risks when deciding what diagnosis is most likely and what care is appropriate.

Clinical Trial

A planned study in which people receive or are observed for an intervention to evaluate its safety, effects, or outcomes. Trials may be conducted in phases and for many types of health interventions.

Clinical Trial Phases

Stages for testing a medical treatment: Phase I mainly examines safety and dose, Phase II studies early effectiveness and safety, Phase III compares it with usual care in larger groups, and Phase IV monitors longer-term use.

Clinicopathologic Correlation

Combining a person's symptoms, examination, scans, laboratory tests, and tissue findings to reach the most accurate diagnosis, especially when a small sample may not show the whole disease.

Clinistix

Clinistix is a reagent-strip method historically used to detect glucose in urine through an enzymatic color reaction.

Clinitest

Clinitest is a tablet-based copper-reduction test historically used to detect reducing substances in urine, including glucose; it is less specific than modern methods.

Clinodactyly

A finger or toe that curves sideways from birth or during development, most often the little finger. It is usually mild but may interfere with movement or occur with a genetic condition.

Clinoid Process

A small bony projection at the base of the skull near the eye socket and major nerves and blood vessels. It helps form the support around the pituitary region and optic canal.

CLIP

A device used to hold tissue or structures together; surgical clips can close blood vessels, mark tissue, or occlude structures such as the vas deferens.

Clitoral

Relating to the clitoris, an erectile organ with a dense concentration of sensory nerves at the front of the vulva.

Clitorectomy

Surgical removal of all or part of the clitoris, sometimes with removal of adjacent vulvar tissue; nonconsensual forms constitute female genital mutilation and can cause serious harm.

Clitoridectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the clitoris. In medicine it may be performed for selected tumors or severe disease; nonmedical removal is a harmful practice with no health benefit.

Clitoris

A small, sensitive erectile organ located at the anterior junction of the labia minora, beneath the clitoral hood (prepuce). The clitoris is the primary source of female sexual pleasure and is homologous to the male penis.

Clitorodynia

Persistent or recurrent pain, burning, or marked sensitivity of the clitoris. Causes may include infection, skin disease, nerve pain, trauma, pelvic-floor dysfunction, or another vulvar pain disorder.

Clitoromegaly

Clitoromegaly is enlargement of the clitoris, which may be congenital or acquired from androgen excess, endocrine disease, medication, or other causes.

Clivus

A central, sloped bony surface on the floor of the posterior cranial fossa formed by the fusion of the basilar part of the sphenoid bone and the basiocciput, extending anterior to the foramen magnum and providing a bed for the pons and basilar artery.

CLL

Alternate name; see *Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia*.

Cloacal Abnormalities

A group of rare birth-related conditions in which the urinary, genital, and intestinal structures do not separate or develop normally. They may affect the bladder, bowel, spine, external genitalia, and reproductive organs.

Cloacal Exstrophy

A very rare birth defect in which the lower abdominal wall, bladder, bowel, spine, and reproductive or urinary organs do not form normally and may be exposed. It is associated with complex surgical and long-term medical needs.

Cloacitis

Inflammation of a cloaca or cloacal region, particularly in disorders affecting the common terminal outlet of the urinary, genital, and intestinal tracts.

Clodronate

Clodronate is a bisphosphonate that reduces bone resorption and is used in selected bone and cancer-related conditions.

Clofazimine

Clofazimine is a riminophenazine antimicrobial used mainly in multidrug treatment of leprosy and selected mycobacterial infections; skin discoloration is common.

Clomifene

Clomifene, or clomiphene, is a selective estrogen-receptor modulator used to induce ovulation in selected infertility settings.

Clomipramine

Clomipramine is a tricyclic antidepressant particularly effective for obsessive-compulsive disorder; anticholinergic, cardiac, and overdose toxicity are important.

Clonal Evolution

The gradual change of a cancer as groups of tumor cells acquire different genetic changes. Groups that grow faster, spread more easily, or resist treatment can become dominant and make the cancer progress or recur.

Clonal Expansion

Multiplication of cells descended from one original cell. It may occur when immune cells respond to a trigger or when an abnormal cell population grows in cancer or another disorder.

Alternate Names:
Clonal Proliferation; Clone Expansion

Clonazepam

Clonazepam is a benzodiazepine anticonvulsant and anxiolytic that enhances GABA activity; sedation, dependence, and respiratory depression can occur.

Clonic Seizure

A seizure causing repeated, rhythmic jerking of muscles. It may affect one part of the body or both sides, with or without loss of awareness; the cause and seizure type are determined from the episode and medical assessment.

Clonidine

Clonidine stimulates central alpha-2 receptors to reduce sympathetic outflow and is used for hypertension and selected other conditions; abrupt withdrawal can cause rebound hypertension.

Clonidine Toxicity

Alpha-2-adrenergic agonist poisoning causing somnolence, miosis, bradycardia, hypotension, respiratory depression, and sometimes transient hypertension early after ingestion. Management is supportive with airway and cardiovascular monitoring; naloxone may improve opioid-like central depression in selected cases.

Clonorchiasis

Infection with the Chinese liver fluke, Clonorchis sinensis. It affects the biliary tract and may cause inflammation, obstruction, and long-term hepatobiliary complications.

Clonus

Repeated, rhythmic muscle jerks triggered by suddenly stretching a muscle, often at the ankle. It commonly indicates overactive reflexes from a problem affecting the brain or spinal cord.

Clopidogrel

Clopidogrel is an antiplatelet drug that irreversibly blocks the platelet P2Y12 receptor, reducing arterial thrombosis risk after selected cardiovascular events or procedures.

Closed-Angle Glaucoma

Glaucoma caused by blockage of the eye's drainage angle, so fluid cannot leave and pressure rises. Sudden attacks can cause severe eye pain, blurred vision, halos, headache, nausea, and permanent sight loss.

Closed Comedo

A small skin lesion formed when a follicular opening is blocked by sebum and keratin but remains covered by the epidermis.

Alternate Names:
Whitehead

Closed Fracture

A fracture in which the broken bone does not communicate through a wound with the external environment.

Closed-Loop Insulin Delivery

Automated insulin delivery systems that combine continuous glucose monitoring with an insulin pump and control algorithm. The algorithm adjusts basal insulin delivery based on sensor glucose values in real time. Hybrid closed-loop systems require user-initiated meal boluses but automatically manage basal rates.

Closed Reduction

Nonoperative realignment of a fractured or dislocated bone or joint by manipulation without surgically opening the site.

Closed Reduction Of A Fractured Bone

A nonsurgical procedure that realigns a broken bone by manipulating it through the skin without opening the fracture site, usually followed by immobilization and imaging to confirm alignment.

Closed Suction Drain With Bulb

A flexible drain connected to a compressible bulb that creates gentle negative pressure to remove blood or fluid from a surgical or injured area; the bulb is emptied and output recorded as directed.

Closed Surgical Wound Care

Care of an incision whose edges are closed with sutures, staples, adhesive, or strips, including keeping it clean and dry as instructed and watching for infection or separation.

Clostridial Infection

Infection caused by anaerobic, spore-forming bacteria of the genus *Clostridium* or related genera such as *Clostridioides*. These infections may cause antibiotic-associated colitis, food poisoning, botulism, tetanus, or destructive wound disease; the species and toxins determine the clinical syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Clostridial Infections; Clostridium Infection

Clostridial Myonecrosis

A rapidly progressive, life-threatening necrotizing infection of skeletal muscle caused primarily by Clostridium perfringens or other histotoxic clostridia. Typically arising after deep traumatic injuries, compound fractures, or surgery, it is characterized by severe pain out of proportion to exam findings, rapid tissue edema, bronze skin discoloration, bullae, palpable gas crepitus, and systemic toxemia.

Alternate Names:
Gas Gangrene; Clostridial Gangrene

Clostridioides Difficile

A spore-forming bacterium that can overgrow after antibiotics disturb normal gut bacteria. Its toxins inflame the colon and cause watery diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, and sometimes life-threatening colitis.

Clostridioides Difficile Colitis

Alternate name; see *Clostridium Difficile Colitis*.

Clostridioides Difficile Infection

Diarrhea and colon inflammation caused by overgrowth of Clostridioides difficile, often after antibiotic use. It may be mild or severe and can recur; diagnosis requires appropriate stool testing in a person with symptoms.

Clostridioides Difficile Pathogenesis

Antibiotics can remove protective bowel bacteria, allowing C. difficile to multiply. Its toxins injure the colon and cause inflammation and diarrhoea, while hardy spores can survive in the environment and spread infection.

Clostridium

A genus of anaerobic, usually spore-forming bacteria that includes species capable of causing diseases such as tetanus, botulism, gas gangrene, and antibiotic-associated colitis.

Clostridium Botulinum

A bacterium that produces botulinum toxin, which blocks nerve signals to muscles and causes weakness or paralysis. Food, wounds, or swallowed spores can cause botulism, a medical emergency affecting breathing and swallowing.

Clostridium Difficile

Former taxonomic name; see *Clostridioides Difficile*.

Clostridium Difficile Colitis

Clostridioides difficile colitis is antibiotic-associated inflammation of the colon caused by toxin-producing bacteria. It causes watery diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, and sometimes severe colitis; diagnosis and treatment depend on symptoms, testing, recurrence, and severity.

Alternate Names:
C. Diff Colitis; Clostridioides Difficile-Associated Diarrhea (CDAD); Pseudomembranous Colitis

Clostridium Difficile Infection

Alternate name; see *C. Difficile Infection*.

Clostridium Perfringens

A bacterium that can cause rapidly destructive muscle infection with gas in tissues or food poisoning with sudden diarrhea and abdominal cramps. Severe wound infection requires emergency surgery and antibiotics.

Clostridium Perfringens Food Poisoning

An acute foodborne toxico-infection caused by ingestion of large numbers of vegetative cells of Clostridium perfringens type A that sporulate in the intestine and produce enterotoxin. It typically develops 6 to 24 hours after eating contaminated cooked meats, poultry, or gravies held at warm temperatures, causing intense abdominal cramps and watery diarrhea that usually subside within 24 hours.

Clostridium Tetani

A soil bacterium whose toxin causes tetanus after entering a wound. It produces painful muscle stiffness and spasms, often beginning in the jaw, and can interfere with swallowing and breathing; vaccination prevents it.

Clot

A semisolid mass of blood formed during clotting. A clot can stop bleeding, but one that blocks a blood vessel can reduce blood flow or travel elsewhere and cause serious injury.

Clot Buster

A medicine that breaks down a blood clot, also called a thrombolytic medicine. It may be used urgently for selected strokes, heart attacks, or lung clots, but it can cause dangerous bleeding and is not safe for everyone.

Cloth Dye Poisoning

Exposure to cloth dyes that may cause irritation, gastrointestinal symptoms, allergic reactions, or systemic toxicity depending on the chemical composition.

Clotrimazole

Clotrimazole is an azole antifungal used topically or orally in selected formulations for fungal infections of skin, mouth, or vagina.

Clotting

The body's process of stopping bleeding by narrowing a damaged vessel, forming a platelet plug, and producing a protein mesh that strengthens the plug. Excessive or inappropriate clotting can block blood vessels.

Cloudy Cornea

Loss of corneal transparency from edema, scarring, infection, dystrophy, trauma, or deposits, potentially causing blurred vision, pain, photophobia, or glare.

Clove Oil

Clove oil contains eugenol and is used in some dental and topical products; concentrated ingestion or exposure can cause irritation, liver injury, or seizures.

Clozapine

Clozapine is an atypical antipsychotic for treatment-resistant schizophrenia and selected suicidality risk; neutropenia, myocarditis, seizures, constipation, and metabolic effects require monitoring.

Clubbing

Enlargement and rounding of the fingertips or toes with more curved nails and loss of the normal nail angle. It may accompany long-term lung, heart, bowel, liver, or other disease.

Clubbing Of The Fingers Or Toes

Bulbous enlargement of fingertip or toe soft tissue with increased nail curvature caused by chronic changes in the nail bed; it can accompany lung, heart, gastrointestinal, or other disease.

Clubbing of the Nails

Rounding and widening of the fingertips or toes with increased nail curvature and loss of the normal nail-fold angle. It may be inherited or associated with lung, heart, gastrointestinal, liver, or other disease; acquired clubbing can accompany progressive illness.

Club Drugs List And Side Effects

Club drugs include substances such as MDMA, ketamine, GHB, and others used recreationally in social settings. Effects may include agitation, hallucinations, seizures, dangerous temperature elevation, respiratory depression, cardiovascular toxicity,

impaired consent, and overdose.

Club Foot

Alternate spelling; see *Clubfoot*.

Clubfoot

A congenital foot-and-ankle deformity in which the foot points downward and turns inward, with the heel tilted inward and the forefoot turned toward the midline. The foot is usually stiff and does not move fully into a normal position. Talipes equinovarus is the common specific form; "clubfoot" may also refer more broadly to other congenital foot-position deformities. It may affect one or both feet.

Clubfoot (Talipes Equinovarus)

Alternate name; see *Clubfoot*.

Clubfoot Repair

Treatment to gradually straighten a baby's turned-in foot, usually with gentle stretching and casts, followed by a brace. Some children need a small tendon procedure or later surgery if the deformity returns or is severe.

Clubhand

A birth defect in which the hand and wrist curve toward the thumb or little-finger side because forearm bones or other tissues developed abnormally. Treatment depends on function and may include therapy or surgery.

Clumping

The gathering of cells, particles, or proteins into groups. In a laboratory sample, clumped red blood cells or platelets can affect test results; in the body, clumping can sometimes block vessels.

Cluster

A group of similar events, findings, cells, or cases occurring together in space, time, or clinical pattern.

Cluster Headache

Repeated attacks of extremely severe pain around or behind one eye, lasting about 15 minutes to three hours. The same side may tear, redden, swell, or feel congested, and the person often becomes restless.

Cluster Headaches

Alternate name; see *Cluster Headache*.

Clutton's Joints

Painless swelling of both knees or other large joints caused by long-term inflammation in children with congenital syphilis. Joint movement is usually preserved; the underlying infection is syphilis.

CMTC

Abbreviation for cutis marmorata telangiectatica congenita, a congenital vascular skin anomaly causing persistent reticulated red or purple mottling. It may be isolated or associated with limb asymmetry, ulcers, or other vascular abnormalities.

CMV

Cytomegalovirus, a common herpesvirus that may cause mild or asymptomatic infection but can cause serious disease in fetuses and people with weakened immunity.

Alternate Names:
Cytomegalovirus (CMV)

CMV Blood Test

A blood test that looks for cytomegalovirus antibodies, viral proteins, or viral genetic material. Antibodies usually show past or recent exposure, while viral material can help detect active infection, especially in people with weakened immunity.

CMV Colitis

Inflammation of the colon caused by cytomegalovirus, usually in someone with severely weakened immunity. It may cause bloody diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or weight loss and is confirmed with appropriate testing, often including biopsy.

CMV Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by cytomegalovirus, usually in people with substantial immune suppression; fever,

cough, shortness of breath, and low oxygen may occur and require targeted evaluation and antiviral treatment.

CMV Retinitis

Infection and inflammation of the retina caused by cytomegalovirus, usually in people with severely weakened immunity. It may cause floaters, blurred or missing areas of vision, and blindness unless treated urgently.

CNS Infection

Infection of the brain, spinal cord, meninges, or cerebrospinal-fluid spaces caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, parasites, or other organisms; presentation and treatment depend on the pathogen and anatomic site.

CNS Lymphoma

A lymphoma involving the central nervous system, most often diffuse large B-cell lymphoma. It may involve brain parenchyma, meninges, eyes, or cerebrospinal fluid.

CO2 Blood Test

A blood chemistry measurement that usually estimates serum total carbon dioxide, which largely reflects bicarbonate. It helps assess acid-base and electrolyte disorders; sodium, chloride, kidney function, and blood-gas results provide additional context.

Coagulate

To change from a liquid to a semisolid or solid state, especially the formation of a blood clot through coagulation.

Alternate Names:
Clot; Clot Formation

Coagulation

The body's process for stopping bleeding by forming a stable blood clot. Platelets first gather at an injured vessel, then blood proteins create a mesh of fibrin that strengthens the plug; too little clotting causes bleeding, while too much can cause harmful clots.

Coagulation Cascade

A linked series of reactions involving blood-clotting proteins that ends by forming fibrin, the mesh that strengthens a platelet plug. Problems at different steps can cause excessive bleeding or harmful clotting.

Coagulation Defects

Problems in blood vessels, platelets, or clotting proteins that make bleeding last too long or cause harmful clots to form. Causes may be inherited, acquired, medicine-related, or due to liver or other disease.

Coagulation Factor

A blood protein required for the coagulation cascade and formation of a stable fibrin clot; deficiencies or inhibitors can cause bleeding, while excessive activation can contribute to thrombosis.

Coagulation Factor Deficiencies

Inherited or acquired disorders in which one or more clotting factors are reduced or function abnormally, causing excessive bleeding. The clinical pattern and laboratory findings depend on the affected factor.

Coagulation Factor V Leiden

An autosomal dominant genetic variant (G1691A point mutation in the factor V gene) that confers resistance to proteolytic cleavage and inactivation by activated protein C (APC resistance), representing the most common inherited thrombophilia in Caucasian populations.

Coagulation Profile

A group of blood tests that assess how quickly blood clots, commonly including prothrombin time/INR and activated partial thromboplastin time. Results help investigate bleeding, clotting, liver disease, vitamin K deficiency, and monitor selected medicines.

Coagulation Time

The time a blood sample takes to form a clot under specified laboratory conditions. Modern tests usually measure particular clotting pathways more precisely to investigate bleeding or abnormal clot-

ting.

Coagulative Necrosis

A type of tissue death, usually caused by loss of blood flow, in which the tissue's basic shape remains for a while. It can occur in most solid organs but usually not in the brain.

Coagulopathy

A disorder of hemostasis, the processes that form and dissolve blood clots. It can impair clot formation or regulation, leading to abnormal bleeding or harmful clots. Causes include inherited clotting disorders, medicines, liver disease, low platelet counts, and severe illness.

Coal Worker's Pneumoconiosis

Lung disease caused by breathing coal dust over many years. It may begin with small areas of dust damage and progress to extensive scarring, causing cough, breathlessness, and reduced lung function.

Coal Workers' Pneumoconiosis (Black Lung Disease)

An occupational lung disease caused by long-term inhalation of coal mine dust. It can produce small nodules and progressive massive fibrosis, leading to cough, breathlessness, impaired lung function, pulmonary hypertension, or respiratory failure; exposure prevention is central.

Coarctation

A localized narrowing of a tubular anatomical structure, especially coarctation of the aorta, which obstructs blood flow and produces characteristic pressure differences.

Coarctation of the Aorta

A narrowing in the aorta, the main artery carrying blood from the heart to the body. It is usually near the branches that supply the head and arms. The narrowing reduces blood flow to the lower body and makes the heart pump harder. Blood pressure may be higher in the arms than in the legs, and pulses in the legs may be weak. Severity ranges from severe narrowing in infancy to mild narrowing found later; other heart defects may occur.

Coarse Crackles

Wet, bubbling sounds heard through a stethoscope as air moves through fluid or secretions in larger airways. They may occur with pneumonia, bronchiectasis, chronic lung disease, or fluid in the lungs and are not specific to one condition.

Coats Disease

An uncommon retinal disorder characterized by abnormal retinal blood vessels, leakage, exudation, and sometimes retinal detachment, usually affecting one eye in childhood.

Cobalamin

Vitamin B12, a nutrient needed for DNA production, healthy red blood cells, nerve function, and normal processing of certain fats and proteins.

Cobalamin Deficiency

Alternate index label; see *Vitamin B12 Deficiency*.

Cobalt

Cobalt is a metal present in vitamin B12 and some industrial materials; excess exposure can injure the heart, thyroid, lungs, or skin.

Cobalt-57

A radioactive form of cobalt used as a test source for checking and calibrating gamma cameras. It is mainly used for equipment quality control and is not normally given to patients as a diagnostic or treatment medicine.

Cobalt-Chromium

A strong, corrosion-resistant metal mixture used for cast dental restorations, partial dentures, crowns, and selected medical devices. Some people may develop sensitivity, and prolonged exposure to cobalt can be harmful.

Cobalt Poisoning

Toxic exposure to cobalt that may cause gastrointestinal, neurologic, thyroid, cardiac, or lung effects

after significant or prolonged exposure.

Cocaine

A stimulant drug that blocks monoamine reuptake and can also act as a local anesthetic; use can cause dependence, cardiovascular complications, seizures, stroke, and overdose.

Cocaine-Associated Cardiomyopathy

Cardiac muscle dysfunction associated with cocaine exposure, which may involve ischemia, myocarditis, arrhythmia, hypertension, or direct myocardial toxicity. Presentation ranges from chest pain and reduced ejection fraction to heart failure or sudden death.

Cocaine Cardiotoxicity

Cocaine overstimulates the heart and blood vessels, raising heart rate and blood pressure and sometimes tightening the heart's arteries. It can cause chest pain, heart attack, dangerous rhythms, heart failure, or sudden death, even without longstanding artery disease.

Cocaine Intoxication

A toxic reaction to cocaine that may cause agitation, overheating, high blood pressure, seizures, abnormal rhythms, heart attack, stroke, or sudden death.

Cocaine-Related Psychiatric Disorders

Alternate name; see *Cocaine Use Disorder*.

Cocaine Substance Use

Use of cocaine, a stimulant that can cause dependence, agitation, seizures, heart attack, stroke, dangerous overheating, and severe psychiatric or cardiovascular complications.

Cocaine Toxicity

A toxic state caused by cocaine, often producing agitation, high blood pressure, rapid heart rate, hyperthermia, seizures, coronary vasospasm, myocardial infarction, or stroke.

Cocaine Use Disorder

A pattern of cocaine use that becomes difficult to control or causes problems with health, work, relationships, or safety. Craving, repeated use despite harm, tolerance, and withdrawal may occur.

Alternate Names:
Cocaine Dependence; Cocaine Abuse; Cocaine Addiction

Cocaine Withdrawal

Physical and emotional symptoms after stopping or reducing cocaine, including fatigue, depressed mood, increased appetite, sleep changes, irritability, and cravings. Severe depression or suicidal thoughts may occur.

Cocarboxylase

Cocarboxylase is thiamine pyrophosphate, the active coenzyme form of vitamin B1 required for several oxidative carbohydrate and amino-acid reactions.

Coccidioides Complement Fixation

A blood test that detects complement-fixing antibodies to Coccidioides; antibody levels can support diagnosis and help assess the severity or progression of coccidioidomycosis.

Coccidioides Immitis

A dimorphic soil fungus and a principal cause of coccidioidomycosis, or Valley fever, acquired by inhaling airborne arthroconidia. Infection is usually pulmonary but can disseminate, especially in people with impaired cellular immunity.

Coccidioides Precipitin Test

A serologic test that detects antibodies to Coccidioides, typically early immunoglobulin M antibodies, and supports evaluation of suspected coccidioidomycosis when interpreted with symptoms and other testing.

Coccidioidomycosis

A fungal infection caused by Coccidioides fungi, usually acquired by breathing spores from disturbed

soil. It most often affects the lungs and causes cough, fever, tiredness, or chest pain; rarely, it spreads to the skin, bones, joints, or brain.

Common name: Valley fever

Coccidioidomycosis and Valley Fever

Infection caused by Coccidioides fungi, acquired by inhaling spores from disturbed soil in endemic regions. It may cause a self-limited respiratory illness, but dissemination to skin, bone, joints, or meninges can occur, especially in pregnancy or immunosuppression.

Coccidiosis

Infection caused by microscopic parasites called coccidia. It usually affects the intestine and may cause watery diarrhea, stomach cramps, vomiting, dehydration, or weight loss; severe or widespread disease is more likely when immunity is weakened.

Coccus

A round or nearly round bacterium. These bacteria may occur alone, in pairs, chains, or clusters; their shape helps describe them but does not identify the species or illness by itself.

Coccydynia

Pain in the region of the coccyx, often worsened by sitting. Causes include trauma, childbirth, degenerative change, and less commonly infection or tumor.

Alternate Names:
Coccygodynia; Tailbone Pain

Coccygectomy

Surgical removal of the coccyx, reserved for selected cases of severe persistent coccygeal pain or a lesion that has not responded to conservative treatment.

Coccyx

The small pointed bone at the bottom of the spine, commonly called the tailbone. It connects to the sacrum, supports pelvic-floor tissues, and may become painful after a fall, childbirth, or prolonged sitting.

Cochlea

The spiral-shaped part of the inner ear that changes sound vibrations into nerve signals. Fluid movement inside it stimulates sensory hair cells, allowing the brain to recognize pitch and loudness.

Cochlear Duct

The coiled, endolymph-filled membranous tube of the inner ear, situated between the scala vestibuli and scala tympani, housing the organ of Corti along its basilar membrane for auditory sensory transduction.

Alternate Names:
Scala Media

Cochlear Implant

A surgically implanted neural prosthetic device designed to restore functional auditory sensation in individuals with severe-to-profound sensorineural hearing loss who derive negligible benefit from conventional acoustic amplification. It bypasses damaged or non-functional sensory hair cells of the organ of Corti to provide tonotopically organized direct electrical stimulation to spiral ganglion neurons of the cochlear nerve (CN VIII). The device comprises external hardware (microphone, speech processor, and magnetic transmitter coil) that captures and digitizes acoustic signals, and internal components (hermetically sealed subcutaneous receiver-stimulator package and an intracochlear electrode array surgically threaded into the scala tympani of the cochlea).

Cochlear Implants

Plural form; see *Cochlear Implant*.

Cockayne Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which cells cannot repair some types of DNA damage normally. It causes poor growth, developmental delay, worsening nerve problems, sensitivity to sunlight, hearing or vision loss, and an appearance of premature aging.

Cockcroft-Gault Formula

An equation that estimates creatinine clearance (CrCl) from serum creatinine, age, body weight,

and sex. The result is multiplied by 0.85 for women. It is used as an estimate of kidney function, particularly for medication dosing, but is less accurate in people with unusual body size or rapidly changing kidney function.

Alternate Names:
Cockcroft-Gault Equation; Creatinine Clearance Estimation Formula

Code Black

A hospital emergency alert for a serious security or safety threat. The exact meaning differs between hospitals, so staff follow the facility's emergency policy.

Code Blue

A hospital alert that summons a team for a person with suspected or actual cardiac or respiratory arrest. Some hospitals also use it for another life-threatening medical emergency. The exact meaning and response can vary by hospital.

Codeine Overdose

Overdose of codeine, an opioid, that can cause respiratory depression, impaired consciousness, pinpoint pupils, and coma. Naloxone may be required in emergency care.

Codman Triangle

A triangular area of new bone seen on an X-ray when a rapidly growing bone lesion lifts the outer covering of bone. It suggests aggressive bone disease but does not identify a specific diagnosis.

Codon

A group of three genetic building blocks in messenger RNA that specifies one amino acid or signals the end of protein production. Several different codons can specify the same amino acid.

Coefficient of Inbreeding

The probability that the two copies of a gene at a locus in an individual are identical by descent from a common ancestor; it is used in population and medical genetics.

Coenzyme

A small organic molecule that helps an enzyme carry out a chemical reaction. Many coenzymes come from vitamins and temporarily carry chemical groups or electrons.

Coenzyme Q

A fat-soluble molecule in mitochondrial membranes that transfers electrons during cellular energy production. It also acts as an antioxidant, and the body makes it naturally, although levels may change with age or illness.

Coenzyme Q10

CoQ10, a lipid-soluble compound in mitochondrial electron transport and an antioxidant; it is also sold as a dietary supplement, although benefits vary by condition.

Cofactor

A nonprotein helper, such as a mineral ion or vitamin-derived molecule, that an enzyme needs to perform a chemical reaction. Without its cofactor, the enzyme may not work normally.

Coffee-Ground Emesis

Vomit containing dark brown or black granular material from blood altered by stomach acid. It may indicate upper gastrointestinal bleeding.

Coffin-Lowry Syndrome

A rare inherited developmental disorder, usually linked to an RPS6KA3 gene change. It can cause intellectual disability, distinctive facial features, short stature, spinal curvature, tapered fingers, and sudden falls triggered by surprise.

Alternate Names:
CLS

Cogan'S Syndrome

A rare immune disorder causing inflammation of the cornea and inner ear. It may produce eye pain, reduced vision, dizziness, ringing, or hearing loss and can sometimes inflame large blood vessels.

Cognition

The mental processes involved in acquiring, storing, retrieving, and using information, including attention, memory, language, reasoning, and judgment.

Cognitive

Relating to mental processes such as attention, memory, learning, language, reasoning, perception, judgment, problem solving, and decision-making.

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy

A structured talking therapy that helps a person identify unhelpful thoughts and behaviors and practice more useful responses. It is used for depression, anxiety, insomnia, pain, and other conditions.

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy For Back Pain

A structured psychological treatment that addresses pain-related thoughts, behaviors, sleep, activity, and coping to reduce disability and improve function in chronic back pain.

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy For Insomnia

A structured talking treatment for persistent insomnia. It changes unhelpful beliefs and habits about sleep and uses methods such as a regular sleep schedule, limiting time awake in bed, relaxation, and stimulus control.

Cognitive Behavior Therapy

A talking treatment that helps a person notice unhelpful thoughts and behaviors and develop more useful ways to respond. It is used for problems such as anxiety, depression, pain, insomnia, and some eating disorders.

Cognitive Behavioural Therapy

A structured psychological treatment that helps a person identify and change unhelpful thoughts and behaviors. It is used for conditions such as anxiety, depression, insomnia, pain, and some eating disorders.

Cognitive Decline

A reduction over time in one or more cognitive abilities, such as memory, attention, language, reasoning, or visuospatial function.

Cognitive Distortion

An inaccurate, irrational, or exaggerated thought pattern that reinforces negative emotions or maladaptive beliefs; see *Cognitive Distortions*.

Cognitive Distortions

Repeated patterns of inaccurate or unhelpful thinking, such as assuming the worst, seeing situations as all good or all bad, or believing one knows what others think. They can worsen anxiety or depression and may be addressed in therapy.

Cognitive Fitness

The active maintenance of mental sharpness and brain health through stimulating activities, physical exercise, social engagement, and proper nutrition. Regular challenges such as learning new skills, puzzles, reading, and social interaction support neuroplasticity and cognitive reserve.

Cognitive Function

The mental abilities used for attention, memory, language, learning, reasoning, judgment, planning, problem solving, and understanding information.

Alternate Names:
Cognition; Cognitive Ability

Cognitive Health And Memory

Cognitive health encompasses the ability to think clearly, learn, remember, and make decisions, with memory being a core component that involves encoding, storing, and retrieving information. Age-related changes in processing speed and recall are normal, but persistent decline may signal mild cognitive impairment or dementia.

Cognitive Impairment

A decline in thinking abilities such as memory, attention, language, judgment, or problem solving. It may be mild with independence preserved or severe

enough to interfere with everyday activities.

Cognitive Rehabilitation

Structured therapy to improve cognitive function or help a person compensate for difficulties with memory, attention, language, or executive skills after illness or injury.

Cognitive Reserve

The brain's ability to use alternative strategies or networks to maintain function despite injury or disease.

Cognitive Screening

A brief assessment used to identify possible problems with memory, attention, language, or other cognitive functions. It does not by itself diagnose dementia or another disorder.

Cognitive Symptoms

Changes in thinking abilities such as attention, memory, processing speed, language, judgment, planning, or problem solving. They may occur with neurologic disease, mental-health conditions, medicines, sleep problems, substance use, or other medical conditions.

Cognitive Therapy

A psychological treatment that helps a person identify and change unhelpful thoughts and beliefs and develop more adaptive behaviors; cognitive behavioral therapy combines it with behavioral methods.

Cogwheel Rigidity

A type of muscle stiffness where moving an arm or leg feels jerky and catches like moving gears, commonly seen in Parkinson's disease.

Cohort

A group of people who share a defined characteristic or experience during a specified period and are studied over time or compared with another group.

Cohort Study

An observational study that identifies groups based on an exposure or other characteristic and compares the incidence of disease or other outcomes between them over time. It may be prospective or retrospective and commonly estimates relative risk.

Coincidence Detection

The PET-scanning method of recording two gamma rays that reach opposite detectors at nearly the same time after a radioactive tracer changes inside the body. Their path helps the scanner locate where the tracer is concentrated.

Coitus

Sexual intercourse, traditionally meaning penile-vaginal penetration; the term does not include every form of sexual activity or intimate contact.

Coitus Interruptus

The withdrawal method of contraception, in which the penis is removed from the vagina before ejaculation; it is less reliable than many other contraceptive methods.

Coke

Slang for cocaine, a stimulant drug; the word can also mean a carbon fuel product, so context is essential.

Cold

Alternate name; see *Common Cold*.

Cold Abscess

A pocket of pus that develops slowly with little redness, warmth, or pain. It may occur with tuberculosis or other long-term infections.

Cold Agglutinin

A type of abnormal immune protein (antibody) that binds to red blood cells when blood cools down below normal body temperature, such as in the fingers, toes, ears, or nose. When this occurs, red blood cells can clump together and be broken down prematurely by the immune system, leading to fatigue, pale or bluish skin in the extremities upon cold exposure, and hemolytic anemia.

Cold Agglutinin Disease

An autoimmune blood disorder in which antibodies become active in cooler parts of the body and cause red blood cells to stick together and break down. It may cause anemia, fatigue, jaundice, or cold-related color changes.

Cold Agglutinins

Plural form; see *Cold Agglutinin*.

Cold Agglutinin Syndrome

A condition in which antibodies become active in cool parts of the body, making red blood cells clump and break down. It may cause anemia or blue, painful fingers and toes.

Cold Allergy

Alternate name; see *Cold Urticaria*.

Cold Exposure

Alternate index label; see *Hypothermia*.

Cold Hands

Hands that feel unusually cold, which may result from environmental exposure, reduced blood flow, Raynaud phenomenon, anemia, thyroid disease, or other medical conditions.

Cold Injury

Harm caused by low temperature, including hypothermia, frostbite, chilblains, and nonfreezing tissue injury. Risk increases with prolonged exposure, wetness, wind, or poor circulation and may affect the whole body or a local area.

Cold Intolerance

Unusual sensitivity or inability to tolerate cold temperatures, which may occur with hypothyroidism, anemia, low body weight, vascular disease, or other conditions.

Cold Ischemia Time

The duration during organ transplantation between the initiation of hypothermic organ preservation perfusion in the donor and the re-establishment of warm arterial blood reperfusion in the recipient, an important determinant of primary graft function.

Cold Medicines And Children

Safety guidance for giving medicines to children with cold symptoms; many combination products provide little benefit in young children and can cause dosing errors or serious adverse effects.

Cold Panniculitis

Inflammation of subcutaneous fat after exposure to cold, producing firm, red or violaceous, sometimes tender plaques or nodules. It is most often seen on the cheeks of infants or on exposed areas and usually improves with warming and avoidance of further cold.

Cold Sore

A recurrent localized viral infection of the vermilion border of the lips or perioral skin caused predominantly by herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) and occasionally HSV-2. Following primary oral inoculation, the virus ascends sensory nerve axons and establishes lifelong latency in the sensory neurons of the trigeminal ganglion. Reactivation is triggered by stressors including ultraviolet radiation, febrile illness, physical trauma, menses, or immunosuppression. Prodromal paresthesias (tingling, pruritus, or burning) precede the eruption of grouped, painful, thin-walled umbilicated vesicles on an erythematous base that rupture, exude serous fluid, and form honey-colored crusts that heal without scarring in 7–14 days. Early administration of oral nucleoside analogues (valacyclovir, famciclovir) shortens healing time and reduces viral shedding.

Cold Sores

Plural form; see *Cold Sore*.

Cold Urticaria

Raised, itchy patches or swelling that appear after the skin is exposed to cold. A large area of cold exposure, such as swimming in cold water, can rarely cause fainting or a life-threatening allergic reaction.

Colectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the colon. It may treat cancer, severe inflammatory bowel disease, diverticular complications, blocked bowel, or inherited high cancer risk; the amount removed depends on the disease.

Colibacillosis

Disease caused by pathogenic strains of Escherichia coli, which may produce intestinal infection, urinary-tract infection, sepsis, or other illness.

Colic

Severe wave-like pain caused by contraction or blockage of a hollow organ, such as the intestine, gallbladder, or urinary tract. The term also describes repeated crying in an otherwise healthy young infant.

Colicky Pain

Intermittent, wave-like cramping pain caused by contraction, distension, or obstruction of a hollow organ; common examples include biliary, renal, and intestinal colic.

Coliform

A group of bacteria used as an indicator of possible contamination in water or food. Finding them does not prove that disease-causing bacteria are present, because many coliforms are harmless environmental organisms.

Colitis

Inflammation of the colon, which may cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, blood or mucus in stool, fever, or urgency. Causes include infection, inflammatory bowel disease, reduced blood flow, medicines, and radiation.

Collagen

A strong protein that forms much of the body's connective tissue. Different types support and strengthen skin, bone, cartilage, tendons, ligaments, blood vessels, and many internal structures.

Collagenase

An enzyme that breaks down collagen, a major structural protein in skin, bone, cartilage, and connective tissue. Natural collagenases help remodel tissue, while medicines or bacterial enzymes can be used in selected treatments or cause tissue damage.

Alternate Names:
Collagen-Digesting Enzyme; Collagen-Degrading Enzyme

Collagen Disease

An older, broad term for diseases that affect connective tissues and often involve abnormal immune activity. Modern medical writing usually names the specific disease instead.

Collagen Implant

A medical material made from or based on collagen, a structural protein, used to support tissue repair or add soft-tissue volume. Sources may be animal-derived or manufactured. Its uses, durability, and risks depend on the product and the treated body area.

Collagenous Colitis

A type of microscopic colitis in which a thick layer of collagen develops beneath the colon lining. It usually causes persistent, watery, nonbloody diarrhea and may require colon biopsy for diagnosis.

Collapsed Arch

Alternate name; see *Flat Feet*.

Collapsed Lung

A common description of pneumothorax, in which air in the pleural space compresses the lung. It may cause sudden chest pain and shortness of breath and can be life-threatening when tension develops. Atelectasis is a different cause of loss of lung expansion, usually involving blockage or compression of lung tissue.

Collapse Of The Lung

See *Lung Collapse*.

Collapsing Glomerulopathy

An aggressive and histologically distinctive variant of focal segmental glomerulosclerosis (FSGS) characterized by global or segmental collapse of the glomerular capillary tuft accompanied by marked hypertrophy and hyperplasia of overlying visceral epithelial cells (podocytes). Associated with human immunodeficiency virus infection (HIV-associated nephropathy), high-risk *APOL1* genotypes, interferon therapy, and severe parvovirus B19 infection.

Alternate Names:
Collapsing FSGS; Collapsing Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis

Collapsing Pulse

A bounding arterial pulse characterized by a rapid, forceful upstroke followed by an abrupt, sudden collapse, best appreciated by elevating the patient's arm while grasping the radial artery with the palmar aspect of the fingers. It is characteristic of aortic regurgitation and high-output states such as severe anaemia, thyrotoxicosis, or arteriovenous fistulas.

Alternate Names:
Corrigan Pulse; Water-Hammer Pulse

Collateral

Providing an alternative or parallel route, such as collateral blood vessels that supply tissue around an obstruction; in other contexts it means accompanying or secondary.

Collateral Circulation

Alternate blood-vessel routes that develop or enlarge when a main artery becomes narrowed or blocked. They may partly maintain blood flow to tissue, but they may not prevent symptoms or injury if the blockage is severe.

Collateral Ligament Injury

A sprain or tear of a strong ligament on the inner or outer side of the knee. It may cause pain, swelling, tenderness, or looseness after a twisting or sideways force; treatment depends on severity and may include a brace and rehabilitation.

Collecting Duct

Small kidney tubes that receive fluid from several filtering units and adjust its water and salt content before it becomes urine. Antidiuretic hormone helps them return water to the blood.

Colles Fracture

A fracture of the distal radius, near the wrist, in which the hand-side fragment tilts or shifts toward the back of the hand (dorsally). It often follows a fall onto an outstretched hand and may involve shortening or fragmentation of the bone.

Alternate Names:
Colles' Fracture; Colles' Fracture

Collimator

A device in an imaging camera that allows radiation traveling in selected directions to reach the detector. It helps form a clearer image, but its design affects the balance between detail and the ability to detect weak signals.

Colloids

Fluids containing large particles that tend to stay in blood vessels longer than simple salt solutions. Some are used to support circulation, but they can cause fluid overload, allergic reactions, or kidney problems and are chosen according to the clinical situation.

Coloboma

A birth defect caused by incomplete formation of part of the eye, leaving a notch or gap in the iris, retina, choroid, or optic nerve. Vision problems vary with the structure and amount affected.

Coloboma Of The Iris

A congenital keyhole- or notch-shaped defect in the iris caused by incomplete embryonic closure, sometimes associated with colobomas in the retina, optic nerve, or other organs.

Colocolonic Intussusception

Telescoping of one part of the colon into the next section. It is uncommon in adults and may be

caused by a polyp, tumor, or other lesion, producing intermittent pain, bloating, vomiting, or altered bowel movements.

Cologne Poisoning

Ingestion of cologne containing alcohol and fragrances that may cause intoxication, hypoglycemia, respiratory depression, or gastrointestinal irritation.

Cologuard

A stool-based colorectal-cancer screening test combining DNA-marker analysis with a fecal blood test; a positive result requires diagnostic colonoscopy.

Colon

The main part of the large intestine between the small intestine and rectum. It absorbs water and salts and stores and moves stool through its ascending, transverse, descending, and sigmoid sections.

Colon Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the colon, usually from gland-forming cells in the bowel lining. Many cases develop from precancerous polyps, but some arise through other pathways. Symptoms may include blood in the stool, a persistent change in bowel habits, abdominal discomfort, unexplained weight loss, fatigue, or iron-deficiency anemia; early cancer may cause no symptoms. Diagnosis usually involves colonoscopy and biopsy, followed by staging to guide treatment. Management may include surgery, chemotherapy, targeted therapy, or immunotherapy depending on the stage and tumor features.

Alternate Names:
Colon Carcinoma; Cancer of the Colon; Bowel Cancer (informal or regional term)

Colon Cancer Prevention

Colorectal-cancer risk can be reduced through recommended screening, physical activity, healthy weight, limiting alcohol, avoiding tobacco, and a diet rich in fiber-containing plant foods. Screening can detect precancerous polyps and early cancer before symptoms develop.

Colon Cancer Screening

Testing intended to detect colorectal cancer or precancerous polyps before symptoms develop in people at average risk. Options include stool-based tests and direct visualization such as colonoscopy; the appropriate method and interval depend on age, risk, prior findings, and local guidelines. People with symptoms or increased inherited or personal risk may need diagnostic or earlier specialist evaluation rather than routine screening.

Colonic Diverticulitis

Alternate name; see *Diverticulitis*.

Colonic Inertia

Abnormally slow movement of stool through the colon, causing persistent constipation, bloating, abdominal discomfort, and infrequent bowel movements. It is diagnosed after other causes of constipation have been considered.

Colonic Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to the colon causing tissue injury. It may produce sudden abdominal pain, bloody diarrhea, and tenderness and can result from low blood pressure, narrowed arteries, clots, medicines, or inflammation of blood vessels.

Colonic Mucosa

The inner lining of the colon. It absorbs water and salts, makes mucus, and contains cells that help protect the colon.

Colonic Polyps

Alternate name; see *Colon Polyps*.

Colonic Pseudo-Obstruction

Massive clinical and radiological dilation of the colon, predominantly involving the cecum and right colon, in the complete absence of a mechanical or physical obstructing lesion; associated with severe non-operative medical illnesses or recent surgery.

Alternate Names:
Ogilvie Syndrome; Acute Colonic Pseudo-Obstruction

Colonic Stenosis

Narrowing of part of the large intestine that makes it harder for stool and gas to pass. Causes include scar tissue, inflammation, cancer, or reduced blood supply; symptoms may include pain, bloating, constipation, vomiting, or bowel blockage.

Colonic Tissue Culture

Microbiologic cultivation and identification of biopsy tissue harvested from the colonic mucosa during colonoscopy to detect fastidious bacterial pathogens, mycobacteria (e.g., *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*), or fungal organisms.

Alternate Names:
Colon Biopsy Culture; Colonic Mucosal Culture

Colonization

The presence and growth of microorganisms on or in the body without tissue damage or illness. Colonization can occur before infection, but it does not by itself explain symptoms or require antibiotics.

Colonoscope

A flexible, lighted instrument with a camera that is inserted through the anus to examine the rectum and colon. It can contain channels for air, irrigation, biopsy tools, or devices used to remove polyps.

Colonoscopy

An examination of the rectum and colon using a flexible camera. It can find inflammation, bleeding, tumors, and polyps and allows tissue sampling or removal of some polyps during the same procedure.

Colon Polyps

Growths from the inner lining of the colon. Many are harmless, but some can slowly become colorectal cancer; removing polyps during colonoscopy can prevent some cancers, and follow-up depends on their number, size, and type.

Alternate Names:
Colorectal Adenomas

Colony-Forming Unit

A laboratory estimate of the number of living microorganisms in a sample, based on the colonies that grow in culture. One colony may come from one organism or from a group of organisms.

Colony-Stimulating Factors

Natural or manufactured substances that signal the bone marrow to make more blood cells. Some are used to prevent or treat low white-cell counts caused by cancer treatment or other illness.

Colorado Tick Fever

A viral infection spread by certain ticks, usually causing sudden fever, headache, tiredness, and muscle aches. Some people develop a rash, nausea, or low blood counts; most recover with supportive care, but severe illness can occur.

Color Blindness

Reduced or absent ability to distinguish certain colors under normal lighting. It is often inherited, especially through X-linked variants, but may also result from eye disease, neurologic disease, aging, or medicines.

Color Doppler

An ultrasound technique that uses colors to show the direction and relative speed of blood flow over a regular gray-scale image. It helps assess vessels, heart valves, and circulation.

Colorectal Adenocarcinoma

The most common cancer of the colon and rectum, arising from gland-forming cells in the bowel lining. It may cause bleeding, anemia, altered bowel habits, pain, or no early symptoms and can spread to other organs.

Colorectal Adenoma

A usually noncancerous gland-forming growth in the colon or rectum that may gradually develop into colorectal cancer.

Colorectal Cancer

Cancer arising in the colon or rectum, including colon cancer and rectal cancer. It may cause bleed-

ing, altered bowel habits, iron-deficiency anemia, abdominal pain, weight loss, or no early symptoms. Diagnosis usually involves colonoscopy and biopsy; evaluation and treatment depend on the tumor's location, stage, and molecular features.

Colorectal Cancer Genetics

The study of inherited variants that increase the risk of colorectal cancer. Important inherited syndromes include Lynch syndrome, involving DNA mismatch-repair genes, and familial adenomatous polyposis, involving the APC gene.

Colorectal Cancer Screening

Testing intended to detect colorectal cancer or precancerous lesions in people without symptoms. Recommended starting age, test, and interval vary by country, guideline, and individual risk; people with symptoms or increased risk may need diagnostic evaluation or earlier screening.

Colorectal Cancer Screening Tests

Tests used to detect colorectal cancer or precancerous polyps in people without symptoms. They include stool-based tests and examinations that visualize the colon, such as colonoscopy, CT colonography, and flexible sigmoidoscopy. The appropriate test and interval depend on age, risk, and local guidance.

Colorectal Polyp

A small growth of tissue that protrudes from the inner lining of the colon or rectum. Most polyps are benign and cause no symptoms, but certain types (known as adenomas) have the potential to slowly transform into colorectal cancer over many years if not detected and removed.

Alternate Names:
Bowel Polyp; Bowel Polyps; Colorectal Polyps

Colorectal Polyps

Plural form; see *Colorectal Polyp*.

Colorectal Surgery

A surgical specialty focused on the medical, endoscopic, and operative care of disorders of the colon, rectum, anus, and pelvic floor. It includes benign and malignant disease, such as colorectal cancer, inflammatory bowel disease, diverticular disease, and anorectal disorders. Procedures may include endoscopic evaluation, bowel resection, reconstruction, and stoma creation.

Color Vision Deficiency

Reduced ability to distinguish some colors, commonly red and green. It is often inherited because of differences in the eye's color-sensing cells, but it can also develop from eye disease, optic-nerve or brain disorders, medicines, or toxins. The type and severity vary.

Color Vision Test

An eye test that assesses the ability to distinguish colors or identify color patterns. It helps detect inherited color-vision deficiency and acquired abnormalities caused by eye, optic-nerve, brain, medicine, or toxic disorders.

Colostomy

Surgery that brings part of the large intestine through an opening in the abdomen, called a stoma. Stool and gas leave through the stoma into a pouch. A colostomy may be temporary or permanent and may be needed for cancer, bowel blockage, severe infection, injury, or other bowel disease. Stoma nurses can teach people how to care for it and return to usual activities.

Alternate Names:
Bowel Stoma; Large Intestinal Stoma; Colic Stoma

Colostrum

The thick yellowish breast fluid made during late pregnancy and the first days after birth. It provides concentrated nutrition and immune protection, especially through antibodies, to the newborn.

Colpitis

Inflammation of the vagina caused by infection, altered vaginal bacteria or yeast, irritation, allergy, or hormonal changes. Symptoms may include discharge, itching, burning, pain, odor, or painful intercourse.

Colporrhaphy

Surgery that repairs a weakened front or back wall of the vagina. It may support the bladder or bowel when pelvic tissues bulge into the vagina and cause pressure, discomfort, or difficulty emptying.

Colposcope

A lighted magnifying instrument used to examine the cervix, vagina, or vulva closely and guide biopsy of suspicious areas.

Colposcopy

An examination using a magnifying instrument to inspect the cervix, vagina, and vulva after a screening test shows an abnormality. The clinician may apply solutions and take tissue samples from suspicious areas.

Colposcopy-Directed Biopsy

A specialized gynecologic diagnostic procedure in which acetic acid- or Lugol iodine-enhanced cervical, vaginal, or vulvar epithelial abnormalities visualized under colposcopic magnification are biopsied for histopathologic evaluation of dysplasia or malignancy.

Alternate Names:
Colposcopic Biopsy; Cervical Punch Biopsy; Directed Cervical Biopsy

Columnar Cells

Tall, roughly column-shaped epithelial cells found in linings such as the digestive tract. They may absorb, secrete, or transport material and can bear cilia or microvilli.

Columnar Epithelium Lined Lower Esophagus

Alternate index label; see *Barrett's Esophagus*.

Coma

A state of profound unresponsiveness in which a person cannot be awakened and does not show purposeful responses. It is a medical emergency with many possible causes.

Alternate Names:
Comatose State; Unconsciousness

Coma Scale

A standardized tool for describing level of consciousness using eye opening, verbal response, and motor response.

Combination Inhalers

Inhalers containing two or more medicines, such as an inhaled corticosteroid with a long-acting bronchodilator. They may simplify regular treatment for asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease; the prescribed device and schedule must be followed.

Combination Therapy

Use of two or more treatments together to address a disease or mechanism. The benefits and risks depend on the condition and the specific combination.

Combined Electrolyte Imbalances

Abnormal blood levels of calcium, phosphate, and potassium. This combination does not have one single cause; each result must be confirmed and interpreted with kidney function, medicines, symptoms, and the rest of the electrolyte panel.

Combined Hormone Therapy

Hormone therapy containing both estrogen and a progestogen, generally used when endometrial protection is needed in a person with a uterus.

Alternate Names:
Estrogen-Progestogen Therapy; Combined Menopausal Hormone Therapy

Combined Hyperlipidemia

A blood-fat disorder with high cholesterol and triglycerides, often increasing harmful lipoproteins and raising the long-term risk of artery disease.

Alternate Names:
Mixed Hyperlipidemia; Combined Hyperlipoproteinemia

Combined Oral Contraceptive Pill

Oral contraceptive formulations containing both an

estrogen (typically ethinylestradiol) and a progestin that prevent pregnancy primarily through feedback inhibition of gonadotropins to suppress ovulation, accompanied by thickening of cervical mucus and endometrial thinning.

Alternate Names:
Combined Oral Contraceptives; COCP; Combination Birth Control Pills; The Pill

Combined Spinal-Epidural Analgesia

A form of regional pain relief that gives medicine into the spinal fluid for rapid relief and places a catheter outside it for continued dosing. It is often used during labor or surgery and requires monitoring.

Comedocarcinoma

A form of ductal carcinoma in situ of the breast characterized by central necrosis within malignant ducts, which may produce a comedo-like appearance.

Comedonal Acne

A form of acne in which open comedones (blackheads) and closed comedones (whiteheads) predominate, with little inflammatory redness or swelling. It results from blockage of hair follicles by sebum and keratin.

Comedones

Plugs of sebum and keratin within hair follicles, appearing as open blackheads or closed whiteheads and representing a primary lesion of acne.

Comfort Measures Only

A care plan focused on relief of pain, breathlessness, distress, and other symptoms rather than treatments intended to prolong life.

Commando Procedure

Extensive heart surgery for severe infection destroying both the aortic and mitral valve areas and the tissue between them. The surgeon removes infected tissue, rebuilds the damaged area, and replaces both valves when necessary.

Alternate Names:
Aortomitral Fibrous Body Reconstruction; Intervalvular Fibrosa Reconstruction

Commensal

Describing a microorganism that lives on or in the body and benefits from the relationship without normally harming the person. Many harmless skin and bowel bacteria are commensal.

Comminuted

Describing a fracture in which one bone breaks into several pieces. These fractures may be caused by high-energy injury and can be unstable or involve nearby tissues, so treatment depends on the bone, alignment, skin, nerves, and blood vessels.

Comminuted Fracture

A broken bone divided into several pieces, usually by a high-energy injury. It may be unstable and damage nearby skin, muscles, nerves, or blood vessels, so treatment depends on the site and severity.

Commissurotomy

Surgical incision or separation of a commissure, especially a fused cardiac valve commissure, to relieve obstruction.

Commode

A portable toilet or chair placed near a bed for a person who cannot easily reach a bathroom.

Common Bile Duct

The tube formed when ducts from the liver and gallbladder join. It carries bile into the first part of the small intestine, where bile helps digest dietary fat.

Common Carotid Artery

One of two major arteries carrying blood from the heart toward the head and neck. Each divides into an internal branch supplying the brain and an external branch supplying the face and scalp.

Common Cold

A viral infection of the nose and throat. It can cause a runny or blocked nose, sneezing, sore throat,

cough, and mild aches or fever. Many different viruses cause colds, which spread through close contact and droplets from the nose or mouth. Most people improve within a week, though a cough or runny nose may last longer.

Alternate Names:
Acute Viral Rhinopharyngitis; Head Cold

Common Cold In Babies

A viral infection of a baby's nose and throat causing a runny or blocked nose, cough, sneezing, and feeding difficulty. Babies may develop dehydration or breathing difficulty, with signs such as poor feeding, fewer wet diapers, or fast breathing.

Common Fibular Nerve

A major nerve that passes around the outer side of the knee into the lower leg and foot. It helps lift and turn the foot and carries feeling from much of the lower leg and top of the foot.

Alternate Names:
Common Peroneal Nerve

Common Iliac Arteries

Two large arteries formed where the abdominal aorta divides. Each artery supplies blood to the pelvis and then divides into arteries serving the pelvic organs and lower limb.

Common Iliac Vein

A vein formed by the union of the internal and external iliac veins. The right and left common iliac veins unite to form the inferior vena cava.

Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms

Medical abbreviations and terms summarize diagnoses, tests, medicines, anatomy, and treatment instructions. Because abbreviations can be ambiguous or unsafe, patients should ask clinicians or pharmacists to explain unfamiliar wording rather than infer its meaning.

Alternate Names:
Medical Acronyms; Clinical Terminology

Common Migraine

A migraine attack without a preceding aura. It usually causes moderate or severe throbbing pain lasting four to 72 hours, often with nausea or sensitivity to light or sound and worsening with routine activity.

Alternate Names:
Migraine Without Aura; Migraine Without Neurologic Aura

Common Peroneal Nerve Dysfunction

Impairment of the common peroneal nerve, often from compression near the fibular head, trauma, surgery, or systemic nerve disease. It may cause foot drop, weakness of ankle eversion or dorsiflexion, and sensory loss over the lateral leg or dorsum of the foot.

Common Peroneal Neuropathy

A peripheral nerve disorder causing weakness of ankle dorsiflexion and eversion, sensory loss over the anterolateral leg and dorsum of the foot, and possible foot drop.

Common Uterine and Ovarian Growths

Three usually noncancerous types of growth: fibroids arise from uterine muscle, cysts are fluid-filled sacs often found in the ovaries, and polyps are tissue projections from the uterine lining or cervix.

Common Variable Immunodeficiency

A primary antibody-deficiency disorder characterized by low immunoglobulin G with low immunoglobulin A and/or M and impaired responses to vaccines. It causes recurrent sinus, ear, and lung infections and may also cause chronic gastrointestinal disease, autoimmunity, enlarged lymph nodes, granulomas, or increased lymphoma risk.

Commotio Cordis

Sudden cardiac arrest after a blunt blow to the chest at a vulnerable moment in the heartbeat, usually without visible damage to the heart. Survival depends on rapid cardiopulmonary resuscitation and defibrillation.

Communicable Disease

An illness caused by an infectious agent or its products that can spread directly or indirectly between people, animals, or environmental sources. Transmission routes include respiratory particles, contact, vectors, and contaminated food or water. Prevention and control depend on the disease and may include immunization, sanitation, treatment, and public-health surveillance or locally required notification.

Alternate Names:
Communicable Diseases; Transmissible Disease

Communicating Hydrocephalus

A buildup of cerebrospinal fluid that enlarges the brain's fluid-filled spaces because the fluid is not absorbed normally after it circulates. It can cause headache, vomiting, walking difficulty, sleepiness, or thinking problems.

Communicating With Patients

The clinical exchange of information, concerns, preferences, and decisions between healthcare professionals and patients, using clear language, listening, empathy, and confirmation of understanding.

Communicating With Someone With Aphasia

Communication strategies for a person with impaired language from brain injury or disease, including short sentences, extra time, visual cues, and supported conversation rather than assuming impaired intelligence.

Communication Disorder

A neurodevelopmental condition involving persistent difficulties in the comprehension, expression, articulation, or social use of verbal or nonverbal language; see *Language Disorder*.

Communicating With Someone With Dysarthria

Communication strategies for a person whose speech muscles are weak or poorly coordinated, including reducing background noise, confirming messages, and using writing or augmentative aids when needed.

Community-Acquired

Acquired outside a healthcare facility or before healthcare exposure. For example, community-acquired pneumonia begins outside a hospital and may involve different organisms and resistance patterns from hospital-acquired disease.

Community Acquired Infection

An infection caught outside a healthcare facility or present when a person is admitted, rather than acquired during recent healthcare treatment. Examples include some lung, urinary-tract, and skin infections.

Community-Acquired Pneumonia

Pneumonia acquired outside a hospital or long-term-care facility. It may cause cough, fever, chest pain, breathlessness, and low oxygen; diagnosis and treatment depend on examination, imaging, severity, likely organisms, comorbidities, and local antibiotic guidance. CURB-65 or PSI can help assess the need for hospital care but does not replace clinical judgment.

Alternate Names:
CAP

Community-Acquired Pneumonia In Adults

A lung infection that begins outside a hospital or long-term-care facility. It may cause cough, fever, chest pain, breathlessness, or low oxygen; treatment and the need for hospital care depend on severity and other health conditions.

Community Health Worker

A trained member of a community who helps connect people with health services, education, prevention, and social support.

Community Mental-Health Treatment

Mental-health assessment, treatment, rehabilitation, and support delivered outside a hospital, such as in clinics, homes, schools, or community programs. It may include medication management, psychotherapy, crisis support, peer support, and help with housing, work, or daily functioning.

Community Rehabilitation

Therapy and support delivered at home, in clinics, or in community settings to improve movement, communication, independence, participation, and daily functioning after illness or injury.

Community Reintegration

The process of returning to everyday life and taking part in work, education, family, social, and leisure activities after illness or injury. Support may include rehabilitation, changes to the home or workplace, transport help, and practical or emotional support.

Comorbidity

The presence of two or more health conditions in the same person. The conditions may affect one another and can make symptoms, medicine choices, and treatment planning more complicated.

Compact Bone

Dense outer bone tissue arranged in strong cylindrical units called osteons. It provides most of the skeleton's strength and protects inner marrow while supporting movement and weight-bearing.

Alternate Names:
Cortical Bone; Dense Bone

Comparison

A reference in an imaging report to earlier studies used to assess whether a finding has changed.

Compartment Pressure

The pressure inside a closed group of muscles, nerves, and blood vessels. If it rises too much, blood flow can fall and cause permanent tissue damage; measurements support but do not replace examination.

Compartment Syndrome

A painful, emergency medical condition that occurs when pressure within an enclosed muscle compartment builds to dangerous levels, usually following a severe fracture, crush injury, or tight bandage or cast. As swelling increases within the inflexible connective tissue (fascia), blood flow to the muscles and nerves is cut off, causing intense, unrelenting pain (often disproportionate to the injury), numbness, and muscle weakness, risking permanent tissue damage if not relieved quickly.

Compensated Heart Failure

Heart failure in which symptoms and fluid buildup are stable or controlled with treatment. The heart failure is still present and can worsen, especially if a new illness or other problem develops.

Competence

A legal determination that a person can make a particular decision or manage a matter. In clinical care, decision-making capacity is assessed for each specific choice.

Competitive Antagonist

A medicine or substance that occupies the same receptor as another substance but does not activate it. By competing for that site, it reduces the other substance's effect; increasing the other substance may overcome the competition.

Competitive Inhibition

Reduced activity of an enzyme when another substance competes with its usual target for the same binding site. The effect is often reversible, and more of the usual target may reduce the inhibitor's effect.

Complement

A group of blood proteins that strengthens immune defense. When activated, complement can mark germs for removal, attract immune cells, increase inflammation, or directly damage some microbes.

Complementary Sequence

A DNA or RNA sequence whose building blocks pair with those of another sequence. This matching allows genetic strands to bind and is used in copying, testing, and regulating genetic information.

Complement C1Q Deficiency

A rare inherited lack of a complement protein needed for immune defense and removal of antibody-bound material. It can cause repeated infections and au-

toimmune illness resembling lupus, including rash, joint, kidney, or blood problems.

Complement C2/C4 Deficiency

Inherited or acquired lack of complement C2 or C4, proteins needed especially for the classical complement pathway. It can increase susceptibility to infections with encapsulated bacteria and autoimmune disease resembling lupus. Testing may show low CH50 with low C2 or C4; management may include vaccination, infection treatment, and care for autoimmune disease or recurrent infections.

Complement C3

A major blood protein in the complement immune system. When activated, it helps mark microbes for removal and promotes inflammation; severe deficiency can cause repeated serious infections.

Complement Cascade

A chain reaction involving many immune proteins in blood and tissues. It marks microbes for destruction, attracts immune cells, increases inflammation, and can directly break holes in some microbes.

Complement Component 4

A blood test measuring complement component C4, part of the classical complement pathway; low levels may occur with immune-complex disease, hereditary angioedema, or complement consumption.

Complement Component C3

A blood test measuring complement component C3, a major protein of the complement immune system; abnormal levels can support evaluation of immune-complex disease, infection, or complement deficiency.

Complement Component Deficiency

A genetically determined deficiency in one of the proteins of the complement cascade, predisposing to recurrent pyogenic infections (early classical components), severe autoimmune immune-complex disorders (C1q, C2, C4), or disseminated *Neisseria* infections (terminal membrane attack complex C5-C9).

Complement Deficiencies

Conditions caused by too little or absent activity of one or more complement proteins. They can increase the risk of particular infections and autoimmune diseases; the effects depend on the missing protein.

Complement Deficiency

Reduced or absent activity of one or more complement proteins, increasing susceptibility to some infections or autoimmune disease.

Complement Fixation Test For C Burnetii

A serologic test detecting complement-fixing antibodies to Coxiella burnetii, the bacterium that causes Q fever; antibody phase patterns and titers help distinguish recent from persistent infection.

Complement System

A group of blood proteins that supports immune defense by destroying microbes and promoting inflammation and phagocytosis.

Complete Blood Count

A blood test that counts red and white blood cells and platelets and measures hemoglobin, the oxygen-carrying protein in red cells. It may also report cell size and other features. A version with a differential gives counts of the main types of white cells. Results can help assess anemia, infection, and blood disorders.

Complete Breech

A type of breech presentation in which the fetus has both hips and knees flexed (in a cross-legged sitting posture) so that the buttocks and feet present together at the maternal pelvic inlet. It accounts for approximately 5–10% of breech presentations.

Alternate Names:
Flexed breech; Complete breech presentation.

Complete Cystectomy

Surgery to remove the entire urinary bladder, usually for invasive bladder cancer. Because urine can

no longer leave through the bladder, the surgeon creates a urinary diversion such as an ileal conduit, a continent reservoir, or a new bladder from bowel.

Complete Denture

A removable artificial set of teeth replacing all teeth in the upper jaw, lower jaw, or both. It rests on the gums and may improve chewing, speech, and appearance but can require adjustment for comfort and stability.

Complete Miscarriage

Pregnancy loss in which all pregnancy tissue has passed from the uterus, usually followed by easing bleeding and cramps. Examination, hormone testing, or ultrasound can help confirm that no tissue remains and distinguish miscarriage from ectopic pregnancy; heavy bleeding, severe pain, dizziness, or fever may occur with complications.

Alternate Names:
Complete Spontaneous Abortion

Complete Response

No detectable evidence of cancer after treatment on the tests used. It does not prove that every cancer cell has been eliminated, and recurrence may still occur.

Complex Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates made of many linked sugar units, including starch and dietary fiber. They occur in foods such as grains, beans, vegetables, and potatoes; fiber is not fully digested and supports bowel function.

Complex Febrile Seizure

A seizure triggered by fever in a young child that lasts more than 15 minutes, affects only part of the body, or happens more than once during the same illness. It can occur with brain infection or another underlying cause. Most children recover fully, but the risk of another seizure is higher than with a simple febrile seizure.

Alternate Names:
Atypical Febrile Seizure; Complicated Febrile Seizure

Complex Regional Pain Syndrome

Long-lasting pain, usually in an arm or leg, that may begin after injury or surgery. The area can become very sensitive and may swell or change color, temperature, or sweating. In type I, no major nerve injury is found; type II follows a known nerve injury. Symptoms and recovery vary.

Alternate Names:
CRPS; Reflex Sympathetic Dystrophy; Complex Regional Dystrophy Syndrome

Compliance

The extent to which a person follows a treatment plan. The term is often replaced by adherence, which recognizes that treatment decisions should be discussed and agreed with the patient.

Complicated Bereavement

Alternate name; see *Complicated Grief*.

Complicated Grief

Persistent, intense grief that substantially interferes with daily functioning and lasts longer than expected for the person's cultural and social context.

Complicated Migraine

An older, nonspecific term for migraine accompanied by prolonged or prominent neurologic symptoms; it may refer to several distinct neurologic syndromes.

Alternate Names:
Migraine with Prolonged Aura; Complex Migraine

Complicated Urinary Tract Infection

A urinary infection associated with functional or structural abnormality, obstruction, catheterization, renal impairment, male anatomy, pregnancy, or another factor increasing treatment failure or complication risk. Causative organisms and antibiotic resistance vary by setting.

Complication

A new problem or harmful effect that develops during or after an illness, treatment, or procedure. Examples include infection, bleeding, organ damage, medicine reactions, and blood clots; seriousness de-

pends on the problem and its effect.

Composite Resin

A tooth-colored material used to repair cavities, chipped teeth, or other defects. It is bonded to the tooth and shaped to match it, but may wear or stain sooner than some harder restorations.

Compound Heterozygote

A person who has two different disease-causing changes in the same gene, one inherited in each copy of the gene. Together, the changes can cause an inherited disorder.

Compounding

Preparation, mixing, or altering of a medicine to meet an individual patient's needs when an appropriate approved product is unavailable.

Compounding Pharmacy

A pharmacy that prepares customized formulations for an individual patient when a suitable commercially manufactured product is unavailable or unsuitable.

Alternate Names:
Compounding Pharmacy Practice; Extemporaneous Pharmacy

Compound Muscle Action Potential

The summated electrical voltage recorded over a muscle belly during a motor nerve conduction study, reflecting the near-simultaneous depolarization of all innervated muscle fibers following supramaximal electrical stimulation of its motor nerve.

Alternate Names:
CMAP; Motor Response

Compound Presentation

An abnormal obstetric presentation in which one or more fetal extremities (most commonly a fetal hand or forearm, and rarely a lower extremity) prolapse alongside the primary presenting part (vertex or breech) into the maternal pelvic inlet. Associated with prematurity, polyhydramnios, high multiparity, contracted pelvic dimensions, and unengaged fetal presenting parts. While minor vertex-hand presentations often resolve spontaneously as the head descends and compresses the extremity upward, persistent compound presentation significantly elevates the risks of prolonged second-stage dystocia, cephalopelvic disproportion, umbilical cord prolapse, and maternal-fetal trauma.

Compound Presentations

Plural form; see *Compound Presentation*.

Comprehensive Geriatric Assessment

A detailed review of an older person's illnesses, medicines, movement, daily activities, memory, mood, nutrition, and support at home. The findings are used to create a coordinated care plan based on the person's goals.

Comprehensive Metabolic Panel

A routine 14-substance blood test combining the eight basic metabolic tests (glucose, calcium, electrolytes, BUN, and creatinine) with six liver and protein tests (ALT, AST, ALP, bilirubin, albumin, and total protein). Commonly ordered before surgery and during acute medical care, it evaluates whether the liver and kidneys can safely clear anesthetics and medications, verifies electrolyte stability to prevent irregular heart rhythms during surgery, and checks protein stores necessary for post-surgical wound healing.

Alternate Names:
CMP; Chem-14; Comprehensive Chemistry Screen

Compress

To press together or apply pressure, as with a bandage or device, or to reduce the volume of something.

Compressed Nerve

Alternate name; see *Pinched Nerve*.

Compression

Pressure applied to tissue or a structure, which may reduce swelling or bleeding but can also impair nerves, blood vessels, or organs when excessive.

Compression Bandage

A bandage that applies controlled pressure to a limb or body part. It may reduce swelling, support injured tissue, or help manage venous disease, but improper use can impair circulation or damage skin.

Compression Fracture

Collapse of a vertebra or other bone because of compression, often related to osteoporosis or trauma.

Compression Fractures Of The Back

Collapse of one or more vertebral bodies caused by weakened bone, often from osteoporosis, or by substantial trauma. It can cause sudden back pain, height loss, kyphosis, and rarely nerve or spinal-cord compression.

Compression Stockings

Elastic garments that apply graduated pressure to the legs, supporting venous return and reducing swelling or selected risks of venous pooling; correct fit and arterial circulation matter.

Compression Therapy

Use of external pressure, usually from garments or bandages, to support venous or lymphatic flow and reduce swelling in selected conditions.

Compression Ultrasound

An ultrasound test in which gentle pressure is applied to a vein. A healthy vein usually collapses; failure to collapse may indicate a blood clot, especially in the deep veins of a limb.

Compressive Atelectasis

Collapse of part of a lung because fluid, air, a tumor, or another process presses on it from outside. The lung may re-expand when the pressure is relieved.

Compton Scattering

A change in the direction and energy of an X-ray or other high-energy photon after it strikes an electron. It creates scattered radiation that can reduce image quality and add unnecessary exposure during imaging.

Compulsions

Repeated actions or mental rituals that a person feels unable to resist, often to reduce distress caused by unwanted thoughts. They take up time or interfere with daily life and may not realistically prevent the feared event.

Compulsive Behavior

Repetitive physical actions or mental rituals that an individual feels strongly driven to perform to neutralize anxiety or prevent a feared event; see *Compulsions* and *Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder*.

Compulsive Gambling

Alternate, nonpreferred label; see *Gambling Disorder*.

Compulsive Obsessive Disorder

Alternate name; see *Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder*.

Compulsive Overeating

Alternate name; see *Binge-Eating Disorder*.

Compulsive Sexual Behavior

Recurrent sexual thoughts or behaviors that are difficult to control and cause significant distress or impairment.

Alternate Names:
Compulsive Sexual Behavior Disorder

Compulsive Sexual Behavior Disorder

A persistent pattern of failure to control intense, repetitive sexual impulses or behaviors, resulting in marked distress or significant impairment and continuing despite adverse consequences. It is not defined simply by a high sex drive or moral disapproval; assessment considers control, distress, consent, and coexisting mental-health or substance-use conditions.

Alternate Names:
Compulsive Sexual Behavior; Problematic Sexual Behavior

Compulsive Stealing

Alternate index label; see *Kleptomania*.

Computational Biology

The use and development of computational, mathematical, and statistical methods to study biological systems and data. It includes analyzing genomic and other molecular data, modeling biological processes, and generating predictions about biological function or disease. It overlaps with bioinformatics, with boundaries that vary by context.

Computational Medicine

An interdisciplinary field that uses mathematical models, computer simulations, and analysis of biological and patient data to understand disease, predict its course, and evaluate diagnostic or treatment strategies. Models can represent processes from molecules to whole organs or patients. Their predictions can inform research and clinical decisions but do not by themselves establish a diagnosis or determine treatment.

Alternate Names:
In Silico Medicine

Computed Tomography

An imaging test that uses rotating X-rays and computer processing to create detailed cross-sectional pictures. It is fast and can show bones, bleeding, organs, blood vessels, tumors, infection, and internal injury.

Computed Tomography Pulmonary Angiography

A CT scan performed after injected contrast highlights the lung arteries. It is commonly used to look for a pulmonary embolism and may also show strain on the heart or other chest abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
CT Pulmonary Angiogram; Pulmonary CT Angiography

Computed Tomography Scan

An X-ray scan processed by a computer to produce cross-sectional images of the body. It can rapidly detect bleeding, fractures, infection, blocked bowel, blood clots, tumors, and many other urgent conditions.

Computed Tomography Urography

A CT scan of the kidneys, ureters, and bladder, usually using contrast material to show the urinary tract. It can show stones, blockage, bleeding, tumors, or structural changes.

Computerized Axial Tomography

Alternate name; see *Computed Tomography*.

Concato's Disease

An old name for progressive polyserositis, inflammation of several serous membranes, such as the pleura, pericardium, and peritoneum, often with fluid accumulating in the chest or abdomen. It may complicate tuberculosis, cancer, or connective-tissue disease and can cause shortness of breath, fatigue, and abdominal swelling.

Concealed Conduction

A heart rhythm event in which an electrical impulse enters part of the heart's conduction system but stops before producing a visible heartbeat. The affected tissue may then delay or block the next impulse and alter the heartbeat pattern.

Concealed Pregnancy

A pregnancy that is deliberately hidden or not recognized until late in pregnancy or childbirth. It may occur because symptoms are mild, pregnancy tests are misleading, or the person is unable or unwilling to recognize the pregnancy; medical assessment is still important.

Concentration

The amount of a substance in a given volume, such as the level of glucose or medicine in blood. It is reported in units such as milligrams per deciliter or millimoles per liter.

Concentric Muscle Action

Muscle action in which a muscle produces force while becoming shorter, such as when lifting an

object.

Conception

The joining of a sperm and egg, usually in a fallopian tube, to form the first cell of an embryo. The resulting cells divide as they travel toward the uterus, where implantation may occur several days later.

Alternate Names:
Fertilization

Conceptus

The product of conception at any stage from fertilization to birth, including the embryo or fetus and supporting tissues such as the placenta, umbilical cord, and fetal membranes.

Conceptuses

Plural form; see *Conceptus*.

Conchae

Curved bony structures covered by mucosa inside the nasal cavity that warm, humidify, and filter inhaled air.

Conclusion

The part of a report that summarizes the main findings and their clinical significance or recommended next steps.

Concomitant

Existing or occurring at the same time as another condition, treatment, or event. Concomitant medicines or illnesses may change diagnosis, treatment choices, expected effects, side effects, or monitoring needs.

Concordance

The frequency with which two people, especially twins, show the same trait or diagnosis. Higher agreement in identical than fraternal twins may suggest a genetic contribution, but shared environment also matters.

Concrescence

A dental abnormality in which two neighboring teeth become joined by the hard tissue covering their roots, while their crowns remain separate. It most often affects back teeth and may complicate extraction.

Concretio Cordis

An abnormal joining or fusion of tissues involving the heart or its surrounding sac. It may result from inflammation, scarring, or a birth defect and can restrict heart movement or interfere with normal function.

Concussion

A mild traumatic brain injury caused by a blow, jolt, or force that changes how the brain works. It may cause headache, dizziness, confusion, memory trouble, nausea, or sensitivity to light. Symptoms often improve but can last for days, weeks, or longer; routine scans may be normal.

Conditioning

Learning in which repeated association or reinforcement changes a behavior or response; in medicine, conditioning can also mean preparing a patient or tissue for a treatment.

Conditions Caused By Deletion Mutations

Deletion mutations remove DNA segments and can disrupt one gene or several neighboring genes. The clinical effect depends on size, location, inheritance, and whether the remaining copy compensates; genetic counseling and testing may clarify diagnosis and recurrence risk.

Condom

A thin barrier sheath worn on the penis or inserted into the vagina that helps prevent pregnancy and reduces transmission of sexually transmitted infections when used correctly.

Alternate Names:
Male Condom; Barrier Contraception; External Condom

Conduct Disorder

A childhood or adolescent disorder involving a persistent pattern of behavior that violates the rights of others or major age-appropriate rules. Examples include aggression, property destruction, deceitfulness, theft, and serious rule violations.

Conduction Aphasia

A fluent aphasic syndrome resulting from a lesion disrupting the arcuate fasciculus connecting Broca area and Wernicke area, characterized by intact auditory comprehension and fluent spontaneous speech, but profound impairment in verbal repetition and prominent phonemic paraphasias.

Conduction Deafness

Hearing loss caused by a problem in the outer or middle ear that prevents sound from reaching the inner ear normally. Earwax, fluid, a damaged eardrum, or changes in the small ear bones may be responsible.

Conduction System

Specialized cardiac cells and pathways that generate and transmit electrical impulses through the atria, atrioventricular node, His bundle, bundle branches, and ventricles to coordinate the heartbeat.

Conductive Deafness

Hearing loss resulting from a problem in the external auditory canal, tympanic membrane, or middle ear that reduces conduction of sound to the inner ear.

Conductive Hearing Loss

Hearing loss caused by a problem in the outer or middle ear that prevents sound from reaching the inner ear normally. Earwax, fluid, a damaged eardrum, bone changes, or ear-bone disease may be responsible.

Condylar Process

The rounded articular projection of a bone, especially the mandibular process that articulates with the temporal bone to form the temporomandibular joint.

Condyle

A rounded projection at the end of a bone that forms part of a joint and helps guide movement against another bone.

Condyloid Joint

A joint in which an oval surface of one bone fits into an oval depression in another bone. It allows bending, straightening, and side-to-side movement, but little rotation.

Condyloma

A wart-like growth, often in the genital or anal area and commonly caused by human papillomavirus; condyloma lata are lesions of secondary syphilis.

Condyloma Acuminata

Alternate name; see *Genital Warts*.

Condyloma Acuminatum

Alternate singular name; see *Genital Warts*.

Condyloma Lata

Broad, flat, moist, whitish or grayish-pink plaques and papules occurring in warm intertriginous skin and mucosal areas (particularly the perianal, vulvar, and scrotum regions) during secondary syphilis, containing abundant highly infectious Treponema pallidum spirochetes.

Alternate Names:
Condylomata Lata; Syphilitic Condyloma

Condyloma Latum

A broad, flat, moist, highly infectious lesion of secondary syphilis, usually around the genitals or anus. It differs from a genital wart and indicates syphilis requiring testing and antibiotic treatment.

Condylomata Acuminata

Alternate name; see *Genital Warts*.

Condylomata Lata

Broad, flat, moist, grayish-white papules occurring in secondary syphilis, typically found in the anogenital region and other intertriginous areas. They are

highly infectious and contain abundant Treponema pallidum organisms. Diagnosis is by darkfield microscopy or serological testing for syphilis.

Cone-Beam Computed Tomography

A dental or facial scan that uses a cone-shaped X-ray beam to create three-dimensional images of teeth, jawbone, and nearby structures. It is useful when three-dimensional detail affects diagnosis or procedural planning.

Cone Biopsy

A surgical procedure that removes a cone-shaped portion of the cervix for diagnosis or treatment of high-grade cervical precancer and to determine whether invasive cancer is present.

Cones

Light-sensitive retinal cells responsible for color vision and sharp detail, working best in daylight or other relatively bright conditions.

Alternate Names:
Cone Photoreceptors; Cone Cells

Confabulation

Unintentional production of inaccurate memories or stories without an attempt to deceive. It may occur with memory disorders or injury affecting the front part of the brain.

Confidentiality

The duty of healthcare professionals and organizations to protect a person's health information from unauthorized access or disclosure. Information may be shared when the patient agrees or when law permits or requires it.

Confirmatory Test

A test used to verify a preliminary or screening result, often with a different method or greater specificity. The method depends on the condition, specimen, timing, and accepted clinical guidelines.

Confluent and Reticulated Papillomatosis

An uncommon skin disorder causing asymptomatic or mildly itchy brown, papillomatous papules and plaques that merge centrally and form a net-like pattern, usually on the upper trunk, neck, or axillae. Diagnosis is clinical after excluding fungal infection and other causes of hyperpigmentation; treatment may include specialist-prescribed antibiotics.

Conformal Radiation Therapy

Radiation treatment planned so that the high-dose region conforms closely to the tumor's three-dimensional shape while limiting exposure of nearby normal tissue.

Confounding

A distortion that occurs when another factor is related to both an exposure and an outcome, making their relationship appear stronger, weaker, or different from reality. For example, age may affect both an exposure and disease risk. Study design and statistical adjustment can reduce confounding.

Confusion

Impaired ability to think clearly, orient, attend, remember, or respond appropriately; sudden confusion is delirium and may indicate infection, medication effect, metabolic illness, stroke, or another emergency.

Confusion Assessment Method

A bedside assessment for delirium. It checks for a sudden or fluctuating change, poor attention, disorganized thinking, and an altered level of alertness; the pattern helps identify delirium but does not replace finding its cause.

Congenital

Present at birth, whether inherited, caused by an early developmental difference, or acquired before birth through infection, exposure, or another condition.

Congenital Adrenal Hyperplasia

A group of usually autosomal recessive disorders in which the adrenal glands cannot make hormones normally. The most common form can cause salt loss, excess androgen effects, early puberty, or genital

differences and may be life-threatening in newborns.

Congenital Anomaly

A structural, functional, or biochemical abnormality present at birth; see *Birth Defect*.

Congenital Anomaly Reconstruction

Reconstructive surgery to restore form and function in a congenital anomaly affecting the face, skull, limbs, hands, trunk, or other body region. Treatment may use local tissue rearrangement, grafts, flaps, implants, staged operations, or microsurgery depending on the defect and the structures involved.

Congenital Antithrombin III Deficiency

An inherited condition in which the blood lacks enough working antithrombin, a natural substance that limits clotting. It increases the risk of clots in deep veins or the lungs, sometimes from a young age.

Congenital Biliary Atresia

Alternate name; see *Biliary Atresia*.

Congenital Birth Defect

A structural or functional abnormality present before or at birth. Causes may include genetic changes, infections, nutritional deficiencies, medicines, environmental exposures, or unknown factors.

Congenital Cataract

Clouding of the eye lens present at birth or developing soon afterward. It can interfere with visual development and may require early eye assessment and treatment to prevent lasting reduced vision.

Congenital CMV

Cytomegalovirus infection acquired before birth. Some babies have small head size, hearing or vision loss, seizures, jaundice, an enlarged liver or spleen, or developmental problems; others appear well initially but develop later hearing loss.

Congenital CNS Malformation

A difference in the structure of the brain, spinal cord, or related tissues that develops before birth. Effects range from none to problems with movement, learning, seizures, breathing, or other functions, depending on the area involved.

Congenital Contractural Arachnodactyly

An inherited condition causing unusually long, slender fingers and toes, stiff or bent joints from birth, thin muscles, and sometimes a curved spine. Joint stiffness often improves with age, but movement and heart or aortic findings may need monitoring.

Congenital Cytomegalovirus

Cytomegalovirus infection present at birth after transmission during pregnancy. Some infants have hearing loss, vision problems, small head size, seizures, or developmental disability; others have no symptoms initially.

Congenital Cytomegalovirus Infection

Cytomegalovirus infection acquired before birth. It may cause hearing loss, developmental problems, microcephaly, or no symptoms.

Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia

A hole in the muscle separating the chest and abdomen that allows abdominal organs to move into the chest before birth. The crowded lungs may be underdeveloped, causing severe breathing problems after delivery.

Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia Repair

Surgery to return abdominal organs to the abdomen and close the opening in the diaphragm. It is performed after the newborn is stable enough for surgery; breathing support may be needed before and afterward.

Congenital Disorder

A medical condition or structural abnormality present in an individual from birth, which may be caused by genetic factors or environmental influences in the womb.

Congenital Fibrinogen Deficiency

An inherited absence or abnormality of fibrinogen that can cause bleeding, thrombosis, or both depending on the specific molecular defect.

Congenital Glaucoma

Glaucoma present at birth or developing in early infancy, usually because the anterior-chamber angle (the eye's fluid-drainage area) formed abnormally. Elevated intraocular pressure can enlarge the eye and cause excessive tearing, photophobia (sensitivity to light), or corneal clouding (clouding of the clear front surface of the eye).

Congenital Heart Defect

A structural abnormality of the heart or major vessels present at birth. It may alter blood flow and range from a small defect with little effect to a serious condition requiring treatment or surgery.

Congenital Heart Defect Corrective Surgery

Surgical or transcatheter interventions designed to anatomically or physiologically correct congenital cardiovascular anomalies (such as atrial/ventricular septal defects, tetralogy of Fallot, or transposition of the great arteries).

Alternate Names:
Congenital Heart Surgery; Pediatric Cardiac Surgery; Corrective Cardiac Repair

Congenital Heart Defects

Alternate form; see *Congenital Heart Defect*.

Congenital Heart Defects In Children

Alternate index label; see *Congenital Heart Defect*.

Congenital Heart Disease

A heart or major blood-vessel problem present from birth. It may change blood flow, cause no symptoms, or lead to breathing difficulty, blue color, poor growth, heart failure, or abnormal rhythms. Treatment ranges from monitoring and medicines to catheter procedures or surgery.

Congenital Heart Disease In Adults

A heart defect present from birth that continues into adulthood; see *Congenital Heart Defect*.

Congenital Heart Murmur

A heart murmur heard in a newborn or infant. It may be innocent or may indicate a structural heart defect; assessment considers the murmur's characteristics and associated symptoms or examination findings.

Congenital Hemolytic Jaundice

Jaundice present from or caused by an inherited condition that increases red-blood-cell destruction, producing excess unconjugated bilirubin; examples include hereditary spherocytosis and some enzymatic defects.

Congenital Hip Dislocation

An older term for a hip whose femoral head is dislocated at birth. Developmental dysplasia of the hip is the broader current term, covering abnormalities from a shallow socket or instability through dislocation; see *Developmental Dysplasia Of The Hip*.

Congenital Hydrocephalus

Hydrocephalus present at birth or caused by a developmental abnormality, genetic condition, or congenital infection; see *Hydrocephalus*.

Congenital Hyperinsulinism

An inherited or developmental disorder in which a baby's pancreas releases too much insulin. This can cause dangerously low blood sugar, poor feeding, seizures, brain injury, or death unless recognized and treated promptly.

Congenital Hyperthyroidism

Excess thyroid hormone in a newborn, most often caused by thyroid-stimulating antibodies passing from a mother with Graves disease. It may cause a fast heartbeat, irritability, poor feeding, poor weight gain, or an enlarged thyroid.

Congenital Hypertrichosis Lanuginosa

A very rare form of congenital hypertrichosis in which fine, soft lanugo-like hair covers much of the body from birth or early infancy. It may occur alone or as part of a genetic syndrome; examination looks for associated dental, skeletal, neurologic, or developmental findings.

Congenital Hypothyroidism

Too little thyroid hormone from birth, most often because the thyroid is missing, misplaced, or underdeveloped, or cannot make hormone normally. Newborn screening and early treatment are essential because untreated deficiency can impair growth and brain development.

Congenital Malaria

The transmission of Plasmodium parasites (predominantly Plasmodium falciparum or Plasmodium vivax) from an infected mother to the fetus across the placenta or during delivery. Although relatively uncommon due to the protective barrier of maternal antibodies and placental syncytiotrophoblast, affected newborns can present in the neonatal period with fever, irritability, severe hemolytic anemia, jaundice, hepatosplenomegaly, thrombocytopenia, and poor feeding.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Plasmodium Infection; Neonatal Malaria

Congenital Malformation

A structural abnormality that develops before birth and is present at birth, caused by genetic, environmental, developmental, or unknown factors.

Congenital Megacolon

A birth condition in which part of the intestine lacks the nerve cells needed to move stool. It causes blockage and enlargement of the bowel above it, with delayed first stool, swelling, vomiting, or severe constipation.

Congenital Melanocytic Nevus

A dark mole present at birth or appearing soon afterward, caused by a collection of pigment-producing cells. Most remain harmless, but larger lesions have a higher melanoma risk and need specialist monitoring.

Congenital Mitral Valve Anomalies

Birth differences in the mitral valve, which controls blood flow from the upper to the lower left heart chamber. The valve may leak or be narrowed, causing no symptoms or leading to breathlessness, poor growth, or heart failure.

Congenital Muscular Dystrophy

A group of inherited muscle disorders causing weakness or low muscle tone at birth or during early infancy. Some types also affect the brain, eyes, breathing, heart, or joints; severity varies widely.

Alternate Names:
CMD; Congenital Dystrophy

Congenital Myasthenic Syndromes

A group of inherited disorders that disrupt communication between nerves and muscles. They cause weakness that worsens with activity and may affect the eyes, swallowing, breathing, or limb movement.

Congenital Myopathies

A group of inherited muscle disorders whose weakness or low muscle tone is present at birth or begins in infancy or childhood. They differ in their genetic cause and biopsy features and may affect movement, breathing, swallowing, the spine, or the heart.

Congenital Nasolacrimal Duct Obstruction

Blockage of the tear-drainage channel present at birth, commonly causing persistent watering or discharge from one or both eyes. Most cases occur because a membrane at the lower end of the duct has not opened normally.

Congenital Nephrotic Syndrome

Severe kidney disease beginning before birth or during the first three months of life, causing large amounts of protein loss in urine, swelling, low blood protein, poor growth, infections, and increased clotting risk.

Congenital Nevi

Multiple melanocytic nevi present at birth or appearing soon afterward. Most are benign, but melanoma risk rises with larger or numerous lesions; changes in colour, size, surface, or symptoms can occur in melanoma.

Congenital Nevus

A dark or raised mole present at birth or soon after. Most are harmless, but larger or unusual moles have a higher risk of melanoma. Imaging or removal is used for selected high-risk moles.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Melanocytic Nevus; Congenital Melanocytic Naevus; CMN; Congenital Pigmented Nevus; Bathing Trunk Nevus

Congenital Penile Curvature

Curvature of the penis present from birth, usually caused by unequal development of the erectile tissues. Mild curvature may need no treatment; significant curvature causing functional difficulty may require specialist assessment.

Congenital Plagiocephaly

A difference in the shape of a baby's head that is present at birth or develops soon afterward. It may result from position before or after birth and differs from craniosynostosis, in which skull bones join too early.

Congenital Platelet Function Defects

Inherited disorders in which platelets do not work normally even though their number may be normal. They can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or excessive bleeding after injury or surgery.

Congenital Pneumonia

A lung infection present at birth, acquired before or during delivery. A newborn may have rapid or difficult breathing, temperature instability, poor feeding, or sepsis.

Congenital Protein C Or S Deficiency

An inherited lack or abnormality of protein C or protein S, natural substances that limit clotting. It increases the risk of blood clots in veins, sometimes beginning in infancy or childhood.

Congenital Pyloric Stenosis

Older name for a condition in which the muscle at a baby's stomach outlet thickens and narrows the opening; see *Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis*.

Congenital Rubella

Fetal infection with rubella virus acquired during pregnancy, potentially causing hearing loss, cataracts, congenital heart disease, developmental impairment, and other findings.

Congenital Rubella Syndrome

Birth defects caused by rubella infection during pregnancy, especially early pregnancy. Affected babies may have hearing loss, cataracts, heart defects, small head size, developmental problems, enlarged organs, or a low platelet count.

Congenital Scoliosis

A sideways curve of the spine caused by vertebrae that formed abnormally before birth. The curve may worsen as the child grows, so its pattern and progression require regular assessment.

Congenital Syphilis

Syphilis infection passed from a pregnant person to the fetus. It can cause miscarriage, stillbirth, premature birth, rash, liver or bone disease, hearing loss, or problems that appear later.

Congenital Toxoplasmosis

Infection with the parasite Toxoplasma gondii passed to a fetus during pregnancy. It may cause eye inflammation, brain changes, enlarged fluid spaces, seizures, hearing or vision problems, or developmental difficulties; some babies have no signs at birth.

Congenital Tracheomalacia

Congenital tracheomalacia is weakness of the infant

tracheal cartilage causing dynamic airway collapse, noisy breathing, cough, or recurrent respiratory symptoms.

Congenital Uterine Anomalies

Structural malformations of the uterus and upper reproductive tract resulting from abnormal development, fusion, or resorption of the embryonic Müllerian ducts; see *Mullerian Duct Anomalies*.

Congenital Vaginal Obstruction

A blockage of the vaginal canal due to a developmental anomaly, such as an imperforate hymen, transverse vaginal septum, or vaginal atresia. The specific anatomy determines whether menstrual flow is obstructed and whether blood accumulates in the vagina or uterus. Vaginal agenesis and OEIS complex are distinct congenital conditions.

Congenital Varicella Syndrome

A rare congenital disorder occurring in infants born to mothers who contracted primary varicella zoster virus infection (chickenpox) during the first or early second trimester of pregnancy (typically 8 to 20 weeks gestation). Clinical hallmarks include zig-zag cicatricial skin scarring in a dermatomal distribution, unilateral limb hypoplasia, chorioretinitis, optic atrophy, microcephaly, and autonomic or central nervous system dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Fetal Varicella Syndrome; Congenital Varicella Embryopathy

Congenital Zika Syndrome

A group of birth problems caused by Zika virus infection during pregnancy. Babies may have a small head, abnormal brain development, eye or hearing problems, stiff joints, or developmental difficulties; care focuses on the child's specific needs because there is no single cure.

Congestion

An excess of blood within vessels or fluid within tissue. Venous congestion occurs when blood cannot drain normally, as in heart failure; pulmonary congestion refers to fluid buildup in the lungs from increased pressure in pulmonary veins. Nasal congestion instead means swelling of the nasal lining.

Congestive Heart Failure

Heart failure with fluid buildup in the lungs or body; see *Heart Failure*.

Congestive Hepatopathy

Liver injury caused by chronically elevated venous pressure, usually from right-sided heart failure or constrictive pericardial disease. It may cause liver enlargement, abnormal liver tests, ascites, and eventually cardiac cirrhosis.

Alternate Names:
Nutmeg Liver; Cardiac Hepatopathy

Congo Red

A histologic dye used to detect amyloid deposits in tissue. Under polarized light, stained amyloid shows characteristic birefringence, often described as apple-green, although the observed colours can vary.

Conization

Surgical removal of a cone-shaped portion of the cervix for diagnosis or treatment of cervical dysplasia or selected early cervical cancers.

Conjoined Twins

Identical twins who are physically joined because the early embryo did not completely separate. They may share organs or body structures, so detailed imaging and care by specialists are needed; the outlook depends on what is shared.

Conjugated Equine Estrogens

A mixture of estrogenic compounds historically derived from the urine of pregnant mares and used in some hormone-therapy formulations.

Alternate Names:
CEE; Conjugated Estrogens

Conjugated Hyperbilirubinemia

An elevation of direct, water-soluble bilirubin in the blood, usually caused by impaired bile formation or

excretion, bile-duct obstruction, or hepatocellular injury. Jaundice, dark urine, pale stools, or itching may occur.

Conjugated Linoleic Acid

A group of related fats found mainly in meat and dairy products and sold as supplements. Claims about weight loss or muscle improvement are inconsistent, and supplements may adversely affect blood sugar or liver function.

Conjunctiva

The thin, clear tissue lining the inside of the eyelids and covering the white part of the eye. It protects and lubricates the eye and helps the eyelids move smoothly across its surface.

Conjunctival

Relating to the conjunctiva, the thin mucous membrane covering the front of the eye and lining the inner eyelids.

Conjunctival Melanoma

A rare malignant melanoma of the conjunctiva, often appearing as a pigmented or occasionally amelanotic lesion on the eye surface. It can recur locally or spread to lymph nodes and distant organs, so ophthalmic examination, biopsy, and surveillance are important.

Conjunctival Squamous-Cell Carcinoma

A cancer arising from the surface cells of the conjunctiva, often near the border of the cornea. It may appear as a persistent growth, redness, or irritation and can invade nearby eye tissue if not treated.

Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the conjunctiva, the membrane lining the inside of the eyelids and covering the white of the eye. It can cause redness, itching or irritation, watering, and discharge, and may result from infection, allergy, or irritants.

Conjunctivoplasty

Plastic or reconstructive surgery of the conjunctiva, performed to repair defects, scarring, adhesions, or other abnormalities of the ocular surface.

Connective Tissue

A diverse type of tissue that supports, binds, protects, and insulates organs and structures throughout the body.

Connective Tissue Disease

A disorder affecting tissues that support and connect organs, often because the immune system attacks the body's own tissues. It may involve skin, joints, muscles, blood vessels, lungs, kidneys, or other organs. Examples include lupus, systemic sclerosis, rheumatoid arthritis, and Sjögren syndrome.

Connexin 26 Deficiency

An inherited change in the *GJB2* gene that can cause hearing loss present from birth. The severity and whether one or both ears are affected can vary.

Alternate Names:
GJB2-Related Deafness; DFNB1 Hearing Loss

Conn's Syndrome

Historical eponym for primary aldosteronism; see *Primary Aldosteronism*.

Conn Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Primary Aldosteronism*.

Consanguinity

A biological relationship between people who share a recent common ancestor; it can increase the chance that both parents carry the same recessive disease variant.

Conscious Sedation For Surgical Procedures

Medicines given during a procedure to make a person relaxed and sleepy while allowing them to respond to voice or touch and usually breathe independently. Continuous monitoring is needed because breathing, blood pressure, and alertness can become dangerously reduced.

Consolidation

An imaging finding in which air in part of the lung's air spaces is replaced by fluid, pus, blood, or cells, making that area appear denser. It may occur with pneumonia, fluid buildup, bleeding, or a tumor; consolidation describes an appearance, not a specific disease.

Consolidation Therapy

Additional treatment given after an initial response or remission to destroy remaining disease and lower the chance of relapse. It may include medicines, radiation, surgery, or a transplant depending on the illness.

Constipation

A condition involving fewer than three bowel movements per week, hard or lumpy stools, difficult or painful passage, straining, or a feeling that the bowel has not emptied completely. Causes include diet, medicines, dehydration, functional bowel disorders, and structural or systemic disease.

Constitutional Delay In Puberty

A common pattern in which puberty starts later than average but eventually progresses normally. Growth and bone development may also be delayed, often with a family history of late puberty.

Constitutional Growth Delay

A normal variant in which height growth and bone maturation are temporarily behind average, often with a family history of late puberty. Most affected children continue growing and enter puberty later than peers but reach a typical adult height.

Alternate Names:
Constitutional Delay of Growth and Puberty; CGD

Constraint-Induced Movement Therapy

Rehabilitation that limits use of a less-affected limb while providing structured practice with an affected limb to improve functional use in selected people.

Constrictive Pericarditis

A chronic condition in which a thickened or scarred, noncompliant sac around the heart restricts diastolic filling. It can cause breathlessness, fatigue, leg or abdominal swelling, enlarged neck veins, and liver congestion; causes include infection, surgery, radiation, or unknown disease.

Consultation-Liaison Psychiatry

Psychiatric care for people who are being treated for a physical illness. The psychiatrist helps assess and treat problems such as confusion, depression, anxiety, substance withdrawal, or difficulty coping during medical care.

Contac Overdose

Overdose of a combination cold medicine that may cause acetaminophen toxicity, antihistamine or decongestant effects, sedation, seizures, or cardiac complications depending on ingredients.

Contact Allergen Testing

Patch testing checks whether a substance causes allergic skin inflammation. Small amounts of suspected allergens are placed on the skin, usually the back, and the area is examined after one or more days for a delayed reaction.

Contact Dermatitis

Skin inflammation caused by direct irritation from a substance or by an allergic immune reaction to a substance touching the skin. Irritant contact dermatitis results from direct skin damage; allergic contact dermatitis is a delayed immune reaction. It can cause redness, itching, dryness, soreness, or blisters.

Contact Lenses

Thin lenses placed directly on the eye to correct vision or deliver selected treatment. Proper fitting, handwashing, cleaning, and replacement are essential because misuse can cause corneal infection, inflammation, or vision-threatening injury.

Contact Precautions

Steps used to prevent spread of germs by touch. They may include gloves and a gown, hand hygiene, a private room, and equipment kept for one patient,

depending on the infection and local policy.

Contact Tracing

Identifying and monitoring persons exposed to infectious disease. Critical for outbreak control. Examples: COVID-19, Ebola, TB.

Contact Urticaria

Hives, itching, or swelling that develop within minutes to about an hour after a substance touches the skin or mucosa. It may be immunoglobulin-E-mediated, such as with latex or foods, or caused by direct irritation; widespread symptoms, wheezing, throat swelling, or faintness suggest anaphylaxis.

Contagious Disease

An infectious disease that can be transmitted directly or indirectly from one person, animal, or source to another.

Contamination

Unwanted microorganisms or other material entering a specimen, surface, medicine, or normally sterile area without causing infection in the person. It can produce misleading test results and must be distinguished from true disease.

Continuing Medical Education

Education after professional training that updates a healthcare worker's knowledge, skills, judgment, and ability to provide safe, effective patient care.

Continuity Of Care

Consistent and coordinated care over time and across clinicians or settings, integrating the patient's history, current needs, treatment plan, and preferences. It supports safety, adherence, prevention, and chronic-disease outcomes.

Continuous Bladder Irrigation

Continuous flow of sterile fluid through a urinary catheter into and out of the bladder. It helps prevent blockage and wash out blood clots or debris, often after urinary-tract surgery.

Continuous Combined Hormone Therapy

A hormone treatment regimen taking estrogen and progestogen continuously, often to manage menopausal symptoms while reducing regular withdrawal bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Continuous Combined HRT; Continuous Estrogen-Progestogen Therapy

Continuous Electronic Fetal Monitoring

Continuous recording of the baby's heart rate and the pregnant person's contractions during labor. It may identify patterns associated with fetal distress or changes in fetal oxygenation.

Continuous Glucose Monitoring

A wearable sensor that measures glucose in fluid beneath the skin at regular intervals and shows current levels, trends, and alerts. It helps manage diabetes but may need confirmation with a blood-glucose test when readings do not fit symptoms.

Continuous Kidney Replacement Therapy

Alternate name; see *Continuous Renal Replacement Therapy*.

Continuous Murmurs

Heart sounds heard during both the heart's contraction and relaxation because blood flows continuously through an abnormal opening or connection. Causes include patent ductus arteriosus and arteriovenous fistula.

Continuous Passive Motion Machine

A device that gently moves a limb through a set range of motion while the person relaxes. It may be used after selected operations, especially knee surgery, but does not replace active rehabilitation.

Continuous Positive Airway Pressure

Noninvasive respiratory support that delivers a constant positive pressure throughout the breathing cycle to keep the upper airway or alveoli open.

Continuous Renal Replacement Therapy

A slow form of dialysis used in intensive care for people with severe kidney failure who are too ill for standard dialysis sessions. It filters the blood and removes extra fluid over many hours, often around the clock.

Alternate Names:
CRRT; CKRT

Continuous Subcutaneous Insulin Infusion

Delivery of rapid-acting insulin through a pump and a subcutaneous infusion set to provide basal insulin and mealtime doses.

Contraception

Any method used to prevent pregnancy, including intrauterine devices, implants, pills, injections, condoms, fertility-awareness methods, and sterilization. Methods differ in effectiveness, duration, side effects, cost, and protection against sexually transmitted infections. The best choice depends on health, preferences, reproductive plans, and access to care.

Contraception And Birth Control

Contraception encompasses methods used to prevent pregnancy, including hormonal options like oral contraceptives, patches, rings, injections, and implants, as well as non-hormonal methods like copper IUDs, barrier methods, diaphragms, and permanent sterilization.

Contraception For Adolescents

Methods to prevent unintended pregnancy. Options: combined oral contraceptives, progestin-only pills, depot medroxyprogesterone acetate, contraceptive implant (Nexplanon), intrauterine devices (IUDs), condoms, and abstinence.

Contraceptive Implant

A small medicine-releasing device placed under the skin, usually in the upper arm, to prevent pregnancy for an extended period. It releases a progestogen and can cause irregular bleeding or other hormone-related effects.

Contraceptives

Methods used to prevent pregnancy, including hormonal medicines, implants, intrauterine devices, condoms, and permanent procedures. Methods differ in effectiveness, duration, and risks; most do not protect against sexually transmitted infections, while condoms reduce but do not eliminate that risk.

Contracted Pelvis

A pelvis whose size or shape is reduced or abnormal enough to interfere with passage of the fetus during labor.

Contractile Proteins

Proteins, especially actin and myosin, that interact inside muscle cells to generate force, shorten fibers, and produce body movement.

Alternate Names:
Muscle Contractile Proteins; Actomyosin Proteins

Contraction

The generation of tension and active mechanical shortening of muscle fibers through actin and myosin cross-bridge cycling. In obstetrics, coordinated, rhythmic contractions of the myometrium driven by oxytocin and locally synthesized prostaglandins promote cervical effacement and dilatation, facilitating the descent and delivery of the fetus. True labor contractions occur at regular, progressively shortening intervals with increasing intensity and cervical change, distinguishing them from Braxton Hicks contractions, which are irregular, low-intensity uterine contractions that do not produce progressive cervical effacement or dilatation.

Contractions

Plural form; see *Contraction*.

Contraction Stress Test

A pregnancy test that records the baby's heart rate while contractions occur, sometimes after gentle stimulation or medicine. Repeated slowing of the heart rate may suggest that the placenta cannot supply enough oxygen during labor.

Contracture

A lasting inability to fully move a joint because nearby muscles, tendons, ligaments, skin, or other tissues have shortened or stiffened. It may follow injury, burns, paralysis, inflammation, or prolonged immobility.

Contracture Deformity

A fixed limitation of movement caused by shortening or tightening of muscle, tendon, ligament, joint capsule, skin, or other soft tissue. It may follow neurologic disease, prolonged immobility, injury, burns, or inflammation.

Contracture Prevention

Measures such as positioning, stretching, exercise, splinting, orthoses, and serial casting that help preserve joint movement in people at risk of fixed shortening.

Contraindication

A condition or circumstance in which a treatment, procedure, or medication should not be used because the potential harm outweighs the expected benefit.

Alternate Names:
Contraindications

Contralateral

On or affecting the side opposite a stated body part or injury. For example, a stroke on the left side of the brain may cause weakness on the right side of the body.

Contrast

A difference that makes structures distinguishable; in imaging, contrast material is administered to improve visualization of organs, vessels, or tissues.

Contrast Agent

A substance given or placed in the body to make organs, tissues, blood vessels, or body spaces easier to see during imaging. Different agents are used for X-ray, CT, MRI, ultrasound, or digestive-tract studies.

Contrast-Associated Acute Kidney Injury

Acute worsening of kidney function occurring after administration of contrast, whether or not contrast is causal. Risk assessment includes baseline kidney function, hemodynamic status, diabetes, nephrotoxins, urgency, and the need to avoid unnecessary contrast exposure.

Contrast Echocardiography

An ultrasound examination of the heart using tiny gas-filled bubbles in the bloodstream to make heart chambers, blood flow, or selected areas of heart muscle easier to see.

Contrast-Enhanced Computed Tomography

A CT scan performed after contrast material makes selected organs, blood vessels, or abnormal areas easier to see.

Contrast-Enhanced Magnetic Resonance Imaging

An MRI scan performed after contrast material makes selected tissues, blood vessels, or abnormal areas easier to see.

Contrast-Enhanced Ultrasound

An ultrasound examination using tiny gas-filled bubbles in the bloodstream to improve pictures of blood flow and help characterize selected liver, heart, blood-vessel, or other lesions.

Contrast-Induced Nephropathy

A sudden decline in kidney function after an imaging test using iodinated contrast, although the contrast is not always the cause. Risk is higher with severe kidney disease, dehydration, low blood pressure, or other kidney stresses.

Contrast Medium

A substance administered or placed in the body to make tissues, organs, or body spaces more visible during imaging.

Alternate Names:
Contrast Agent; Radiographic Contrast Material

Contrast Radiology

Imaging of the gastrointestinal tract using contrast material, such as barium, to outline the esophagus, stomach, intestine, or colon on radiographs or fluoroscopy.

Contrast Reaction

An unwanted response after an imaging contrast agent, ranging from nausea, itching, or a rash to breathing difficulty, low blood pressure, or a severe allergic-like reaction. Previous contrast reactions are relevant to risk assessment.

Contrecoup

An injury occurring on the side of an organ opposite the site of impact, especially a brain injury produced when the brain moves within the skull after trauma.

Control Group

The comparison group in a study, which may receive usual care, a placebo, or no intervention according to the study design.

Controlled Cord Traction

Gentle pulling on the umbilical cord after the placenta has separated, while supporting the uterus. A trained birth attendant may use it to help deliver the placenta and reduce blood loss.

Controlled Ovarian Hyperstimulation

Use of hormone medicines to make several ovarian follicles mature at the same time for fertility treatment. Ultrasound and blood tests guide dosing and help reduce the risk of ovarian hyperstimulation, a potentially serious complication.

Alternate Names:
COH; Ovarian Stimulation

Controlled-Substance Schedule I

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with high misuse potential and no accepted medical use under federal law.

Controlled-Substance Schedule II

A United States legal category for medicines with accepted medical uses but high misuse, dependence, or overdose potential. Prescribing, dispensing, refills, and storage are subject to strict rules.

Controlled-Substance Schedule III

A United States legal category for medicines with accepted medical uses and less misuse potential than Schedule II substances, although dependence and misuse remain possible. Rules vary by medicine and jurisdiction.

Controlled-Substance Schedule IV

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with accepted medical uses and lower misuse potential than Schedule III drugs.

Controlled-Substance Schedule V

A United States controlled-substance category for drugs with the lowest level of misuse potential among the federal schedules.

Controllers

Long-term asthma medicines taken regularly to reduce airway inflammation, prevent symptoms and attacks, and lower the need for quick-relief inhalers.

Alternate Names:
Controller Medicines; Maintenance Asthma Therapy

Contusion

A bruise caused by a blunt blow that damages small blood vessels without breaking the skin. It may cause pain, swelling, and discoloration; severe injuries can damage muscle, organs, or deeper tissues.

Alternate Names:
Contusions

Conus Medullaris Syndrome

A group of symptoms caused by damage to the lower end of the spinal cord. It may cause back pain, weakness or numbness in the legs and pelvic area, and loss of bladder, bowel, or sexual function.

Convergence

The inward movement of both eyes so that they are

directed toward the same nearby object.

Convergence Insufficiency

Difficulty turning both eyes inward together to focus on something nearby. It can cause eyestrain, headaches, blurred or double vision, and reading difficulty, especially in children and young adults.

Conversion Disorder

A condition causing genuine problems such as weakness, abnormal movements, loss of sensation, or seizure-like episodes because of altered nervous-system functioning. The symptoms are not intentionally produced and can interfere with daily life.

Convulsion

A sudden episode of involuntary, often rhythmic muscle contractions that may occur with a seizure or other disturbance of brain function. It describes the motor activity, and not all seizures cause convulsions; some produce staring, unusual sensations, altered awareness, or other non-motor symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Convulsive Episode; Seizure-Related Motor Activity

Cooking Without Salt

Preparing food with little or no added sodium to reduce dietary sodium intake, often useful in blood-pressure or fluid-retention management when combined with an individualized eating plan.

Cooley's Anemia

Alternate index label; see *Thalassemia*.

Coombs Test

A blood test that detects antibodies affecting red blood cells. It helps investigate immune-related destruction of red cells and checks compatibility before some blood transfusions.

Cooper's Ligament

Fibrous connective-tissue septa extending from the deep surface of the breast toward the skin and pectoral fascia. Tumor invasion or fibrosis may cause skin retraction.

Coordination

The ability to control movements smoothly, accurately, and in the correct order. It depends on the brain, nerves, muscles, vision, and balance and may be tested with simple hand or leg movements.

COPD

See *Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease*.

COPD And Other Health Problems

The interaction between chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and conditions such as cardiovascular disease, osteoporosis, depression, diabetes, and lung cancer, which can complicate symptoms and care.

COPD Exacerbation

Acute worsening of respiratory symptoms beyond normal day-to-day variation in a patient with COPD that leads to additional therapy. Common triggers include viral or bacterial infection, air pollution, and cardiopulmonary comorbidity.

COPD Flare-Ups

Acute worsening of breathlessness, cough, or sputum beyond usual daily variation in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, often triggered by infection, pollution, or other irritants.

COPD Maintenance Medications

Pharmacologic agents administered on a daily, scheduled regimen to prevent exacerbations, reduce symptoms, and slow airflow limitation in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, including long-acting muscarinic antagonists (LAMAs), long-acting beta-2 agonists (LABAs), and inhaled corticosteroids (ICS).

Alternate Names:
COPD Controller Medications; Long-Acting COPD Bronchodilators; COPD Maintenance Therapy

COPD Rehabilitation

A supervised program combining exercise, breathing strategies, education, nutrition, and support to help people with COPD breathe and function better,

remain active, and reduce the effects of flare-ups.

COPD Rescue Medications

Short-acting inhaled bronchodilators administered on an as-needed basis to rapidly relieve acute dyspnea and bronchoconstriction during COPD symptom flares, encompassing short-acting beta-2 agonists (SABAs) and short-acting muscarinic antagonists (SAMAs).

Alternate Names:
COPD Quick-Relief Drugs; COPD Reliever Inhalers; Fast-Acting COPD Bronchodilators

CO Poisoning

Illness caused by breathing carbon monoxide, an odorless gas that prevents blood from carrying oxygen normally. It may cause headache, dizziness, nausea, confusion, fainting, seizures, or death.

Copper

An essential trace element required for iron transport, connective-tissue cross-linking, energy metabolism, neurotransmitter synthesis, and antioxidant enzymes. Deficiency can cause anemia, neutropenia, impaired neurologic function, and bone abnormalities; excess is toxic and accumulates in Wilson disease.

Copper Deficiency

A lack of copper, a trace element needed for iron transport, connective tissue, nerve function, and pigment production. It may follow malnutrition, malabsorption, gastrointestinal surgery, excess zinc, or an inherited disorder such as Menkes disease, and can cause anemia, low white-cell count, bone changes, and nerve or spinal-cord damage. Copper replacement treats deficiency when intake or absorption is inadequate.

Copper In Diet

Copper obtained from foods such as shellfish, nuts, seeds, beans, whole grains, and organ meats. The body needs small amounts, while excessive supplements or exposure can be harmful; requirements vary with deficiency or disease.

Copper Poisoning

Toxic exposure to copper or copper salts that may cause vomiting, abdominal pain, hemolysis, liver injury, kidney injury, or shock.

Coprolalia

Saying obscene or socially inappropriate words without meaning to. It is an uncommon vocal tic and can occur in Tourette syndrome.

Copy Number Variant

A genetic change in which a section of DNA is missing or present in extra copies. Whether it affects health depends on its size, location, genes, inheritance, and available evidence.

Copy Number Variation

A deletion or duplication of a section of DNA that changes how many copies are present. Some variations are harmless, while others alter gene activity and cause developmental, neurologic, or other disorders.

CoQ10

A fat-soluble substance made by the body that helps mitochondria produce energy and also acts as an antioxidant. It is sold as a supplement, but benefit varies by condition and it can interact with medicines.

Cor

A Latin anatomical word meaning heart, appearing in medical terms that describe the heart, heart-related structures, or diseases affecting circulation.

Coracoid Process

A hook-shaped bony projection from the shoulder blade that points forward. Several muscles and ligaments attach to it, and injury may occur with a direct blow or shoulder dislocation.

Cord

A long, narrow structure such as the spinal cord, which contains the central nervous tissue, or the umbilical cord, which connects a fetus to the pla-

centa.

Cord Blood Stem Cells

Blood-forming stem cells collected from the umbilical cord and placenta after birth. They can make different types of blood and immune cells and may be used for stem-cell transplantation.

Cord Blood Testing

Laboratory testing of blood collected from the umbilical cord at birth, which may include blood type, complete blood count, blood gases, glucose, or tests for infection or inherited disease when clinically indicated.

Cord Prolapse

An obstetric emergency in which the umbilical cord descends through the cervix ahead of the presenting fetal part; see *Umbilical Cord Prolapse*.

Cordocentesis

A prenatal procedure using ultrasound guidance to take a small blood sample from the umbilical cord. It can assess fetal anemia, infection, or selected genetic conditions but carries risks including bleeding and pregnancy loss.

Cordotomy

A procedure that cuts selected pain-sensing pathways in the spinal cord to relieve severe pain when other treatments have failed. It may cause numbness, weakness, breathing problems, or other lasting nerve complications.

Cord Presentation

A position in which the umbilical cord lies between the baby's presenting part and the cervix while the membranes are intact. If the membranes break, the cord may slip down and become compressed, threatening the baby's oxygen supply.

Core Biopsy

Removal of one or more cylindrical tissue samples with a hollow cutting needle for microscopic examination. It preserves more tissue architecture than fine-needle aspiration and is used for breast, liver, prostate, and other lesions.

Core Needle Biopsy

Removal of small cylinders of tissue with a hollow cutting needle for laboratory examination. Imaging may guide the needle, and the samples preserve tissue structure better than fluid or cell aspiration alone.

Cori Cycle

A process in which muscles send lactate to the liver, where it is changed into glucose. The glucose returns to the blood and can be used again by muscles for energy.

Cori Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot break down stored glycogen normally. It can cause low blood sugar, an enlarged liver, muscle weakness, and sometimes heart disease.

Alternate Names:
Glycogen Storage Disease Type III (GSD III); Forbes Disease; Debrancher Deficiency

Corn

A sharply demarcated, conical hyperkeratotic lesion of the stratum corneum that develops over bony prominences subject to repetitive mechanical friction and localized compression. The inverted apex points inward toward the dermis, provoking focal sharp pain when direct perpendicular pressure is applied. Categorized into hard corns (heloma durum), classically located over the dorsolateral aspect of the fifth digit or interphalangeal joints, and soft corns (heloma molle), found within interdigital web spaces where maceration softens the keratin core. Distinguished from plantar verrucae by the preservation of normal skin dermatoglyphic skin lines and the absence of pinpoint thrombosed capillary petechiae upon paring.

Alternate Names:
Clavus; Heloma; Corns

Corn-Cockle Poisoning

Poisoning caused by ingestion of corn cockle

(*Agrostemma githago*) seeds, which may contaminate grain and cause stomach upset, weakness, or other toxic effects.

Alternate Names:
Githism (obsolete historical term); Agrostemma Githago Intoxication

Cornea

The transparent, curved front surface of the eye, covering the iris and pupil. It protects the eye and provides much of its focusing power by bending incoming light toward the retina. Its layered structure includes an outer epithelium, a strong central stroma, and an inner endothelium that helps maintain corneal clarity.

Corneal Abrasion

A scratch or loss of the outer layer of the cornea, often from a fingernail, foreign body, contact lens, makeup tool, or other injury. It can cause pain, tearing, redness, light sensitivity, and blurred vision.

Corneal Cross-Linking

A treatment that uses riboflavin and ultraviolet light to strengthen the cornea. It can slow or stop worsening thinning and bulging, especially in keratoconus, but may cause pain during healing.

Corneal Degeneration

A group of acquired corneal changes that may involve deposits, thinning, blood-vessel growth, or tissue irregularity. Unlike corneal dystrophies, degenerations are not usually inherited and may be asymmetric or develop with age or other eye disease. Effects on vision vary with the type and location.

Corneal Disease

Corneal disease affects the transparent front surface of the eye through infection, inflammation, trauma, dystrophy, degeneration, dryness, or abnormal shape. Pain, redness, light sensitivity, discharge, or reduced vision can occur in sight-threatening disease because scarring may impair vision.

Corneal Dystrophy

A group of usually inherited disorders in which abnormal material builds up in one or more layers of the cornea. They may cause blurred vision, glare, pain, or recurrent corneal erosions and often affect both eyes.

Corneal Edema

Swelling of the cornea from excess fluid, making it cloudy and causing blurred vision, glare, halos, or pain. Causes include damage to its inner cells, glaucoma, inflammation, injury, or eye surgery.

Corneal Endothelium

The innermost layer of cells in the cornea. It moves extra fluid out of the cornea and helps keep it clear.

Corneal Epithelium

The thin outer layer of the cornea that protects the eye and helps keep its surface smooth.

Corneal Implant

A device or tissue substitute placed in or on the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye, to change its shape, replace damaged tissue, or improve vision. Benefits and risks depend on the implant and eye condition.

Corneal Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Keratitis*.

Corneal Injury

Damage to the clear front surface of the eye, including scratches, foreign bodies, chemical burns, infections, or cuts that may threaten vision.

Corneal Laceration

A cut through part or all of the cornea, usually caused by sharp trauma or a foreign object. It can cause pain, tearing, light sensitivity, reduced vision, and leakage of aqueous humor.

Corneal Reflex

An involuntary protective reflex resulting in bilateral blinking upon mechanical or tactile stimulation of either cornea. The sensory afferent limb is mediated by the ophthalmic division of the trigeminal

nerve (cranial nerve V1) and the motor efferent limb is carried by the facial nerve (cranial nerve VII) supplying the orbicularis oculi muscles.

Alternate Names:
Blink Reflex; Corneal Blink Reflex

Corneal Stroma

The thick middle layer of the cornea. It gives the cornea much of its strength and helps keep it clear.

Corneal Surgery

Surgery on the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye, to treat disease or injury, restore its integrity, or change its shape. Procedures include corneal transplantation, wound repair, and laser reshaping.

Corneal Transplant

Surgery that replaces part or all of a damaged or diseased cornea with healthy donor tissue. It may restore vision or relieve pain; risks include rejection, infection, increased eye pressure, and need for further treatment.

Corneal Transplantation

Surgical replacement of part or all of a diseased or damaged cornea with donor corneal tissue to restore vision or relieve pain.

Alternate Names:
Corneal Transplant

Corneal Ulcer

A loss of tissue forming an open sore on the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It is most often caused by infection with bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites, but may also follow an injury, severe dryness, poor eyelid closure, or contact-lens problems. It may cause eye pain, redness, tearing, discharge, sensitivity to light, or blurred vision. Healing can leave a corneal scar, and a deep or central ulcer can seriously damage vision or perforate the eye.

Corneal Ulcers And Infections

Infection or inflammation of the cornea that may produce an epithelial defect or ulcer, pain, redness, tearing, discharge, and light sensitivity. Bacterial, fungal, protozoal, and viral causes can threaten vision.

Corneitis

Inflammation of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It may cause pain, redness, watering, light sensitivity, or blurred vision and can result from infection, injury, immune disease, or chemical exposure.

Cornelia De Lange Syndrome

A genetic developmental disorder that can cause distinctive facial features, slow growth, intellectual disability, limb differences, feeding problems, hearing loss, and heart or other organ abnormalities. Severity varies widely.

Corns

Plural form; see *Corn*.

Corns And Calluses

Corns are small, localized areas of thickened skin caused by repeated pressure or friction, usually on the toes. Calluses are broader areas of thickened, hardened skin, usually on the soles of the feet or palms of the hands. Both are usually harmless but may become painful.

Cornual Pregnancy

An imprecise term historically used for an interstitial ectopic pregnancy, implanted in the portion of the fallopian tube that traverses the uterine wall. It has also been used for pregnancy in a rudimentary uterine horn; the intended anatomy should therefore be specified.

Coronal

Relating to a plane that divides the body into front and back portions, or to the crown or top of a structure.

Coronal Caries

Tooth decay affecting the crown, the visible part of a tooth above the gum. It can begin in pits, grooves, or smooth surfaces when bacterial acids

dissolve enamel and dentin.

Coronal Plane

A vertical plane that divides the body or an organ into front (anterior) and back (posterior) portions.

Coronary

Relating to the arteries and blood flow that supply the heart muscle. Narrowing or blockage of these arteries can reduce oxygen to the heart and cause chest pain or a heart attack.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Blood-Vessel-Related; Heart-Coronary

Coronary Aneurysm

An abnormal widening or ballooning of a coronary artery. It may result from atherosclerosis, inflammation, infection, injury, or a congenital condition and can cause clotting, blockage, or rarely rupture.

Coronary Angiography

An X-ray examination of the heart arteries after contrast is injected through a thin catheter. It shows narrowed or blocked areas and can guide treatment, but the procedure can cause bleeding, stroke, kidney injury, or other complications.

Coronary Angioplasty

A procedure that opens a narrowed or blocked artery supplying the heart. A thin tube with a small balloon is guided to the blockage. The balloon is inflated to widen the artery, and a small mesh tube called a stent is often left in place to help keep it open.

Alternate Names:
Percutaneous Coronary Intervention; PCI; Coronary Balloon Angioplasty; PTCA

Coronary Arteries

The blood vessels that arise from the aorta and supply oxygen to the heart muscle. The right and left arteries divide into branches, and blockage in one can cause angina or a heart attack.

Coronary Artery

One of the blood vessels branching from the aorta that supplies oxygen-rich blood directly to the heart muscle.

Coronary Artery Aneurysm

A weakened section of an artery supplying the heart that has become abnormally widened. It may form a blood clot, reduce blood flow, or rarely rupture; causes include artery disease, inflammation, infection, or injury.

Coronary Artery Anomaly

A birth difference in where a heart artery begins, how it travels, or how it ends. Some cause no problems, while others reduce blood flow or increase the risk of chest pain, dangerous rhythms, or sudden cardiac arrest.

Coronary Artery Bypass

A surgical procedure that creates a new route for blood flow around a narrowed or blocked coronary artery using a vascular graft.

Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting

Surgery that uses a blood-vessel graft to create a route around severely narrowed or blocked heart arteries. It can improve blood flow and symptoms and may improve survival in selected people with extensive disease.

Coronary Artery Bypass Surgery

Alternate name; see *Coronary Artery Bypass Grafting*.

Coronary Artery Calcium Score

A CT scan measurement of calcium in the arteries that supply the heart. It can help estimate future heart disease risk in some people who have no symptoms, but it does not show every type of artery disease.

Alternate Names:
Agatston Score; CAC Score

Coronary Artery Disease

A condition in which fatty plaque builds up in the arteries that supply blood to the heart muscle, narrowing them and reducing blood flow. It may cause no symptoms, chest discomfort (angina), or a heart attack, and can lead to heart failure or abnormal heart rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Coronary Heart Disease

Coronary Artery Fistula

An unusual connection between an artery supplying the heart and a heart chamber or another blood vessel. It may cause no symptoms or lead to breathlessness, chest pain, abnormal rhythms, heart failure, or infection of the heart lining.

Coronary Artery Spasm

Temporary tightening of a heart artery that reduces blood flow and may cause chest pain, often at rest. Smoking, stimulant drugs, stress, or other vessel problems can trigger it.

Coronary Calcium Score

A CT measurement of calcium in the arteries supplying the heart. More calcium usually means more plaque and higher future cardiovascular risk, but a zero score does not exclude soft plaque or eliminate all risk.

Coronary Calcium Scoring

A computed tomography scan measuring calcium-containing plaque in heart arteries. The score helps estimate future cardiovascular risk in selected people but does not show all plaque or replace clinical assessment.

Coronary Care Unit

A hospital unit for people with serious or unstable heart conditions. Staff continuously monitor heart rhythm, blood pressure, oxygen, and other vital functions and provide urgent treatment for problems such as heart attack, dangerous rhythms, or heart failure.

Alternate Names:
CCU

Coronary Circulation

The network of arteries and veins that supplies the heart muscle with oxygen and removes waste. Blood flow increases when the heart works harder and falls when an artery is narrowed or blocked.

Coronary Computed Tomography Angiography

A noninvasive CT scan performed after injected contrast highlights the heart arteries. It can show plaque, narrowing, or blockage and is useful for selected people with suspected coronary artery disease.

Alternate Names:
Coronary CT Angiography; Cardiac CTA

Coronary Dominance

The pattern describing which heart artery gives rise to the vessel supplying the back part of the heart. Most people have right dominance; left or shared patterns are normal variations.

Coronary Endarterectomy

Surgery removing hardened plaque from the inner lining of a heart artery. It may improve blood flow in selected complex blockages but is uncommon and carries risks of heart attack, bleeding, or vessel injury.

Alternate Names:
Coronary Plaque Endarterectomy; Coronary Endarterectomy Procedure

Coronary Flow Reserve

The ratio of coronary blood flow during maximal vasodilation to flow at rest. It measures how much the coronary circulation can increase blood flow; a low value may reflect obstructive coronary artery disease, microvascular dysfunction, or both.

Alternate Names:
CFR

Coronary Insufficiency

Blood flow through the heart arteries is not enough to meet the heart muscle's need for oxygen, usually because the arteries are narrowed. It may cause

chest pain, especially during exertion, or a heart attack.

Coronary Microvascular Angina

Chest pain caused by poor blood-flow regulation in the heart's smallest blood vessels. The main heart arteries may look open on testing, but the small vessels do not deliver enough oxygen during stress or sometimes at rest.

Coronary Microvascular Disease

Alternate name; see *Small Vessel Disease*.

Coronary Microvascular Dysfunction

Abnormal function of the small heart vessels that limits blood flow even when the major arteries are not severely narrowed. It may cause chest pain, especially in women and people with diabetes or high blood pressure.

Coronary Occlusion

Obstruction of a coronary artery, commonly by atherosclerotic plaque and thrombus, that can cause myocardial ischemia or infarction.

Coronary Perfusion Pressure

The physiological net pressure gradient driving myocardial blood flow through coronary capillary beds, calculated as the difference between aortic diastolic pressure and left ventricular end-diastolic pressure.

Alternate Names:
CPP

Coronary Revascularization

Restoration of blood flow through the coronary arteries, usually by percutaneous coronary intervention (angioplasty with or without stenting) or coronary artery bypass grafting. It is used to treat selected obstructive coronary artery disease and acute coronary syndromes.

Coronary Sinus

A large vein on the back of the heart that collects deoxygenated blood from the heart muscle and drains it into the right atrium.

Coronary Slow Flow Phenomenon

Delayed passage of contrast through the epicardial coronary arteries during angiography despite no obstructive coronary disease. It may be associated with impaired microvascular function and ischemic chest discomfort; microvascular dysfunction is not itself the definition of the angiographic slow-flow phenomenon.

Alternate Names:
CSFP; Slow Coronary Flow; Primary Coronary Slow Flow

Coronary Spasm

Alternate name; see *Coronary Artery Spasm*.

Coronary Steal Phenomenon

A situation in which blood is diverted toward healthier heart muscle and away from an area already receiving too little blood. It can worsen chest pain during certain medicines or stress tests.

Alternate Names:
Coronary Steal Syndrome; Myocardial Steal

Coronary Steal Syndrome

A hemodynamic phenomenon in which pharmacologically induced vasodilation (such as with dipyridamole or adenosine) diverts blood flow away from an already maximally dilated, stenotic coronary vascular bed toward well-perfused non-stenotic vessels, worsening regional myocardial ischemia.

Coronary Stent

A small mesh tube placed in a narrowed heart artery to help keep it open after angioplasty. Medicines are usually needed afterward to reduce the risk of clotting.

Coronary Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot in a coronary artery, potentially obstructing blood flow and causing myocardial infarction.

Coronavirus

A family (*Coronaviridae*) of enveloped, positive-sense single-stranded RNA viruses possessing the

largest genomes among RNA viruses (≈ 27–32 kb). Characteristic surface spike (S) glycoprotein projections create a crown-like halo appearance on transmission electron microscopy and mediate viral entry by binding to host receptors (such as ACE2 for SARS-CoV and SARS-CoV-2, or DPP4 for MERS-CoV). Four endemic human coronaviruses (HCoV-229E, NL63, OC43, HKU1) cause mild-to-moderate upper respiratory infections (common cold), while zoonotic spillovers have produced virulent pandemic pathogens causing acute respiratory distress syndrome (ARDS), systemic hyperinflammation, and multiorgan failure, notably SARS-CoV, MERS-CoV, and SARS-CoV-2.

Alternate Names:
Coronaviruses; Coronaviridae

Coronavirus (COVID-19) and Asthma

COVID-19 in a person with asthma may worsen breathing symptoms or trigger an exacerbation, although risk varies with asthma control and severity.

Coronavirus (COVID-19) and High Blood Pressure

COVID-19 in a person with hypertension may carry higher risk when other cardiovascular or age-related risk factors are present. Prescribed blood-pressure medicines should generally be continued unless the treating clinician advises otherwise.

Coronavirus (COVID-19) and Pregnancy

SARS-CoV-2 infection during pregnancy can increase the risk of severe maternal illness, hospitalization, preterm birth, and other complications. Vaccination and individualized treatment can reduce some risks.

Coronavirus Disease 2019

Alternate index label; see *COVID-19*.

Coronavirus Disease COVID-19

Alternate index label; see *COVID-19*.

Coronaviruses

Plural form; see *Coronavirus*.

Corporeal

Relating to the physical body rather than thoughts, feelings, or the spirit. In medical writing, the word may describe a bodily symptom, physical examination, or treatment directed at the body.

Cor Pulmonale

Enlargement and weakening of the right side of the heart caused by high pressure in the lung arteries, usually from long-term lung disease. It may cause breathlessness, leg swelling, enlarged neck veins, or liver congestion.

Corpus

Latin for body; in anatomy it refers to the main body of an organ or structure, such as the corpus callosum or corpus uteri.

Corpus Albicans

A dense, white fibrous scar tissue mass within the ovary formed by the regression and involution of an unfertilized corpus luteum, consisting of hyalinized collagen and degenerated luteal cells.

Alternate Names:
White Body

Corpus Callosum

A broad band of nerve fibers connecting the brain's left and right halves. It allows the two sides to share information needed for movement, sensation, language, vision, and thinking.

Corpus Cavernosum

One of two columns of erectile tissue in the penis that fill with blood during erection.

Alternate Names:
Cavernous Body; Penile Corpus Cavernosum

Corpus Luteum

The temporary endocrine structure formed from an ovarian follicle after ovulation; it produces progesterone during the luteal phase and early pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Yellow Body; Luteal Body

Corpus Luteum Cyst

A usually harmless ovarian cyst that forms after ovulation when the normal hormone-producing structure fills with fluid or blood. It often disappears within a few menstrual cycles but may cause pelvic pain, delayed menstruation, or bleeding if it ruptures.

Corpus Luteum Cysts

Plural form; see *Corpus Luteum Cyst*.

Corpus Spongiosum

A column of erectile tissue surrounding the penile urethra and expanding distally to form the glans.

Alternate Names:
Spongy Body; Corpus Spongiosum Penis

Corrected Age

The developmental age of a premature baby after allowing for the weeks born before 40 weeks of pregnancy. It helps interpret growth and milestones, usually during the first two years.

Corrigan Pulse

A strong pulse that rises quickly and then collapses rapidly. It is classically associated with aortic-valve leakage but can occur with other high-flow states.

Corrosive

A chemical that destroys tissue on contact, such as a strong acid or alkali. Exposure can burn skin, eyes, airways, or the digestive tract; effects depend on the substance and duration of contact.

Corrosive Ingestion

Swallowing an acid, alkali, or other substance that can burn or destroy the mouth, throat, esophagus, or stomach. It may cause pain, drooling, vomiting, difficulty swallowing, or breathing problems and can lead to perforation.

Corrugator Muscle

A small facial muscle that pulls the eyebrows downward and inward, helping create frowning and other concentrated facial expressions.

Alternate Names:
Corrugator Supercilii; Glabellar Muscle

Cortex

The outer layer of an organ or structure. Examples include the brain's cerebral cortex, the outer part of the adrenal gland, and the outer layer of a hair.

Alternate Names:
Cortical Layer; Outer Cortex

Cortical

Relating to the cortex, the outer layer of an organ such as the brain, kidney, or adrenal gland.

Cortical Bone

Dense bone forming the outer shell of most bones and providing much of the skeleton's mechanical strength.

Alternate Names:
Compact Bone; Cortical Tissue

Cortical Cataract

A cataract that begins in the outer part of the eye's lens and forms spoke-like cloudy areas extending inward. It can cause glare, halos, and blurred vision, especially in bright light.

Corticobasal Degeneration

A rare, progressive disease that damages brain cells involved in movement and thinking. It may cause stiffness or slow movement, often worse on one side, poor coordination, speech trouble, or difficulty using a hand or arm. These symptoms are called corticobasal syndrome, which can also result from other brain diseases.

Corticospinal Tract

The primary descending somatic motor pathway originating from pyramidal neurons in layer V of the cerebral motor cortex, descending through the internal capsule, brainstem, and medullary pyramids (where 85 to 90 percent decussate) to synapse on spinal lower motor neurons for voluntary fine motor control.

Alternate Names:

Pyramidal Tract

Corticosteroid

A class of steroid hormones synthesized from cholesterol within the adrenal cortex, or their synthetic pharmacological analogues. Divided into glucocorticoids (primarily cortisol/hydrocortisone, synthesized in the zona fasciculata under ACTH regulation) and mineralocorticoids (primarily aldosterone, synthesized in the zona glomerulosa under renin-angiotensin-aldosterone system control). Glucocorticoids cross the plasma membrane, bind intracellular glucocorticoid receptors, and translocate to the nucleus to downregulate pro-inflammatory cytokines (via NF-κB and AP-1 inhibition) and upregulate anti-inflammatory proteins (lipocortin-1). Clinically utilized for immunosuppression, rheumatologic disorders, asthma, allergic reactions, and adrenal insufficiency; chronic therapy carries risks of secondary adrenal suppression, iatrogenic Cushing syndrome, osteopenia, hyperglycemia, and opportunistic infection.

Corticosteroids

Plural form; see *Corticosteroid*.

Corticosteroids Mechanism

Corticosteroids enter cells and switch genes that control inflammation and immune activity. They reduce the release of inflammatory chemicals and limit the movement and activation of several immune cells, easing swelling, pain, and tissue damage.

Corticosteroids Overdose

Overdose of corticosteroids that may cause gastrointestinal symptoms, mood changes, hyperglycemia, fluid retention, infection risk, or adrenal suppression.

Corticotropin-Releasing Factor

A hypothalamic hormone that stimulates the pituitary gland to release adrenocorticotropic hormone and helps coordinate the stress response.

Alternate Names:
Corticotropin-Releasing Hormone; CRH

Corti's Ganglion

A group of nerve-cell bodies inside the cochlea that carries hearing signals from the inner ear toward the brain. Damage to this pathway can contribute to sensorineural hearing loss.

Cortisol

The principal glucocorticoid steroid hormone produced by the adrenal cortex, the outer part of the adrenal glands above the kidneys. It helps regulate metabolism and blood glucose, maintain blood pressure, modulate immune and inflammatory responses, and support the body's response to stress. Its secretion follows a daily rhythm, rising before waking and generally peaking around waking before declining to low levels at night.

Cortisol Blood Test

A blood test measuring cortisol, a hormone produced by the adrenal cortex. Results help evaluate adrenal insufficiency or cortisol excess, but vary substantially with time of day, stress, illness, medicines, and the assay used.

Cortisol Urine Test

A test measuring cortisol excreted in a timed urine collection, commonly 24-hour urine free cortisol, used to evaluate suspected excess cortisol production such as Cushing syndrome.

Cortisone

A corticosteroid that is converted in the body to cortisol and can be used to reduce inflammation or replace glucocorticoid activity.

Cor Triatriatum

A rare birth defect in which a membrane divides the upper left heart chamber into two spaces. If the membrane blocks blood returning from the lungs, it can cause breathlessness, poor growth, or heart failure; some people have no symptoms.

Coryza

Acute inflammation of the nasal mucous membranes with nasal discharge and obstruction, commonly occurring in the common cold or other upper-

respiratory infection.

Cosmeceutical

A cosmetic product marketed as having biologically active, drug-like benefits; the term has no uniform formal regulatory category in many jurisdictions.

Cosmetic Allergies

Cosmetic products can cause irritant dermatitis or allergic contact dermatitis, producing itching, redness, swelling, scaling, or blistering where applied. Stopping the suspected product and medical assessment, sometimes with patch testing, help identify the responsible ingredient.

Cosmetic Dermatology

Dermatologic care intended to change appearance rather than treat disease, including procedures for wrinkles, scars, pigmentation, hair, or facial volume. Risks include infection, scarring, pigment changes, allergic reactions, and injury from improperly performed treatment.

Cosmetic Ear Surgery

Surgery to change the size, shape, or position of the outer ear, often to correct prominent ears or a structural difference. Risks include bleeding, infection, scarring, altered sensation, and an unsatisfactory result.

Cosmetic Surgery

Surgery intended primarily to change or improve appearance rather than treat disease or restore function. It still carries risks such as infection, bleeding, anesthesia complications, scarring, and unsatisfactory results.

Costal Cartilage

Flexible cartilage that connects the front ends of the ribs to the sternum or to the cartilage of the rib above. It gives the chest wall flexibility during breathing.

Costal Groove

A shallow groove along the lower inner border of a rib that contains an intercostal nerve and blood vessels.

Costal Margin

The lower curved edge of the rib cage, formed mainly by the cartilage of the lower ribs.

Costello Syndrome

A rare genetic condition, usually caused by an HRAS gene change, affecting growth, development, skin, heart, and muscles. It may cause feeding difficulty, short stature, distinctive facial features, heart disease, and increased risk of certain tumors.

Costochondritis

Inflammation of the cartilage where one or more ribs join the breastbone (sternum), causing localized chest-wall pain and tenderness that may worsen with movement, deep breathing, coughing, or pressing the area. Similar pain can also result from heart or lung disease.

Alternate Names:
Costosternal Inflammation

Costochondritis And Tietze Syndrome

Costochondritis is inflammation or irritation at the junction of ribs and the breastbone, causing reproducible chest-wall pain. Tietze syndrome is a less common related condition with visible swelling at one or a few joints; heart and lung emergencies must still be excluded.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Chest Wall Syndrome

Costosternal Chondrodynia

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.

Costosternal Syndrome

Alternate index label; see *Costochondritis*.

Costotransverse Joint

A joint where the tubercle of a rib meets the transverse process of a thoracic vertebra. It helps guide rib movement during breathing.

Costovertebral-Angle Tenderness

Pain elicited by percussion over the angle between the lower ribs and spine. It may occur with kidney infection or other renal and surrounding conditions, and is interpreted with the rest of the examination and clinical findings.

Costovertebral Joint

A joint where a rib meets a vertebra in the spine. It helps the ribs move during breathing.

Cotard Syndrome

A rare syndrome involving a fixed belief that one is dead, missing body parts, or no longer exists, sometimes accompanied by severe depression, psychosis, or other psychiatric or neurologic illness. It is a descriptive syndrome rather than a standalone diagnosis.

Cot Death

Alternate name; see *Sudden Infant Death Syndrome*.

Cotton-Wool Spots

Small, fluffy, whitish-yellow retinal lesions representing localized micro-infarcts of the retinal nerve fiber layer caused by occlusion of precapillary arterioles and subsequent axoplasmic stasis. They are commonly observed on funduscopic examination in diabetic retinopathy, severe hypertension, and retinal vein occlusion.

Alternate Names:
Cytoid Bodies; Retinal Nerve Fiber Layer Infarcts

Cough

A protective reflex that clears mucus, irritants, or foreign material from the airways. Coughs may be short-lived or persistent and can result from infection, allergy, asthma, reflux, medicines, heart disease, or other conditions.

Cough Augmentation

Techniques that help a person with weak breathing muscles clear mucus. They may include assisted coughing, taking several stacked breaths, or using a device that pushes air in and then rapidly pulls it out.

Cough Headaches

Head pain triggered by coughing, sneezing, straining, laughing, or another sudden pressure increase. Some are caused by a structural brain problem, while others occur without an identified structural cause.

Cough In Adults

A cough in an adult may be acute, subacute, or chronic and may result from infection, asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, reflux, upper-airway cough syndrome, medication, or other disease. Coughing blood, breathing difficulty, chest pain, low oxygen, or persistent unexplained cough can accompany serious illness.

Coughing Up Blood

Expectoration of blood or blood-streaked sputum from the lower respiratory tract, called hemoptysis; heavy bleeding or breathing difficulty is an emergency.

Cough Suppressant

An antitussive medicine or measure that reduces the urge or reflex to cough. Suppressing a productive cough can interfere with airway clearance.

Cough Syncope

A brief faint caused by coughing, which raises chest pressure, reduces venous return and cardiac output, and transiently lowers cerebral blood flow.

Councilman Body

A rounded, intensely eosinophilic apoptotic hepatocyte globule with condensed pyknotic or fragmented nuclear material seen on microscopic examination of liver biopsies, characteristic of acute viral hepatitis, yellow fever, and severe toxic hepatitis.

Alternate Names:
Councilman-Rocha Lima Body; Apoptotic Hepatocyte

Countercurrent Multiplication

A kidney process that creates a concentrated salt

gradient deep in the kidney. This gradient allows the collecting ducts to reclaim more water when antidiuretic hormone is present.

Counterfeit Drug

A product falsely labeled as an approved medicine or made to imitate one. It may contain the wrong ingredient, too little or too much active drug, contaminants, or no active drug and can cause treatment failure or poisoning.

Counterpulsation

Timed inflation and deflation of a balloon or pressure cuffs with each heartbeat to improve blood flow to the heart or reduce the heart's workload. It is used only in selected serious cardiac conditions.

Countertransference

A healthcare professional's emotional responses to a patient, influenced by the professional's experiences or by the interaction. Recognizing these responses helps maintain safe, objective, and effective care.

Counting Carbohydrates

Estimating the grams of carbohydrate in foods and drinks to help plan meals, match insulin, and manage blood glucose, especially in diabetes.

Count Rate

The number of detected events each second during measurement. In medical imaging, very high rates can cause missed events because equipment needs recovery time, reducing accuracy unless corrected.

Coup-Contrecoup Injury

Brain injury in which the brain is damaged both beneath the point of impact and on the opposite side as it moves inside the skull. Falls and vehicle crashes are common causes.

Courvoisier Sign

A painless, enlarged gallbladder in a person with jaundice, traditionally suggesting blockage of the bile duct by a tumor rather than a gallstone. It is a clue, not a diagnosis.

Covered Vascular Stent

A vascular stent lined with a graft material that supports the vessel and excludes a leak or aneurysm from the bloodstream.

Alternate Names:
Stent Graft; Endovascular Graft; Endoprosthesis

Cover Test

An objective ocular alignment test used to identify and measure manifest strabismus (tropia). While the patient fixes their gaze on a target, one eye is covered and the uncovered eye is observed for any compensatory refixation movement.

COVID-19

Coronavirus disease caused by infection with SARS-CoV-2. Illness ranges from asymptomatic or mild disease to pneumonia, respiratory failure, thrombosis, or death; common symptoms include fever, cough, shortness of breath, fatigue, muscle aches, and altered taste or smell. Some people develop persistent symptoms after the acute infection.

COVID-19 Antibody Test

A blood test that detects antibodies produced in response to SARS-CoV-2 infection or vaccination; it does not reliably diagnose current infection or establish complete immunity.

COVID-19-Associated Anosmia and Ageusia

COVID-19 can temporarily impair smell and taste through infection or inflammation of nasal and olfactory pathways. Most people improve, but persistent loss, distortion, poor nutrition, or neurologic symptoms warrants follow-up and smell-retraining advice.

COVID-19 Complications

Complications of SARS-CoV-2 infection can include pneumonia, hypoxemic respiratory failure, blood clots, myocarditis, acute kidney injury, neurologic disease, multisystem inflammatory syndrome, and persistent post-COVID symptoms.

COVID-19 in Infants and Children

COVID-19 in children and infants is often mild but can cause pneumonia, dehydration, croup-like illness, or multisystem inflammatory syndrome in children. Breathing difficulty, poor feeding, unusual sleepiness, or dehydration may occur in severe illness.

COVID-19 In Pregnancy

COVID-19 during pregnancy can be more severe than in nonpregnant adults and increases risks such as hospitalization, preterm birth, and stillbirth. Fetal infection before birth is uncommon but possible; vaccination can reduce the risk of severe disease.

COVID-19 Recovery

Recovery after COVID-19 varies from days to months. Persistent fatigue, breathlessness, cognitive symptoms, loss of smell or taste, and post-exertional worsening may represent post-COVID condition and warrant appropriate evaluation.

COVID-19 Symptoms

Symptoms of SARS-CoV-2 infection, which may include fever, cough, sore throat, congestion, fatigue, muscle aches, headache, loss of smell or taste, vomiting, or diarrhea.

COVID-19 Test

A test for current SARS-CoV-2 infection using a respiratory sample. Molecular tests detect viral genetic material and antigen tests detect viral proteins; results depend on timing, sample quality, and the amount of virus present.

COVID-19 Testing

Testing for SARS-CoV-2 uses antigen or nucleic-acid methods on respiratory samples. Test timing, symptoms, exposure, and the purpose of testing affect interpretation and the need for repeat testing.

COVID-19 Vaccines

Vaccines that prime immune responses against SARS-CoV-2 and reduce severe disease, hospitalization, and death; products, schedules, effectiveness, and recommendations vary by age and risk.

COVID-19 Virus Test

Alternate name; see *COVID-19 Test*.

COVID Toe

A chilblain-like skin lesion reported in association with COVID-19, usually affecting the toes or fingers and appearing red, purple, or swollen.

Cowden Disease (Multiple Hamartoma Syndrome)

Alternate names; see *Cowden Syndrome*.

Cowden Syndrome

An inherited PTEN-hamartoma tumour syndrome, usually caused by a pathogenic *PTEN* variant. It may cause multiple hamartomas, characteristic mucocutaneous lesions, and increased risks of breast, thyroid, endometrial, kidney, and colorectal cancers; lifelong organ-specific surveillance is important.

Cowper's Gland

One of a pair of small male accessory sex glands below the prostate. Its secretion contributes mucus and fluid to the urethra before ejaculation.

Cowpox

A zoonotic viral infection caused by cowpox virus or related orthopoxviruses, producing localized pustular or ulcerative skin lesions and sometimes systemic illness.

Cow's Milk Allergy

Alternate name for cow's milk protein allergy; see *Milk Allergy*.

Cow's Milk And Children

Nutritional guidance on cow's milk for children, balancing protein, calcium, vitamin D, fat, iron, allergy, and total intake so milk does not displace a varied diet.

Cow's Milk Introduction in Infancy

Pediatric nutritional guidance establishing that unmodified whole cow's milk should be withheld as a primary beverage until 12 months of age due to its

high renal solute load, low iron bioavailability, risk of occult gastrointestinal blood loss, and inadequate micronutrient profile.

Alternate Names:
Cow's Milk in Infancy; Infant Milk Guidelines; Whole Milk Introduction

Cox-2

Cyclooxygenase-2, an inducible enzyme that produces inflammatory prostaglandins; selective COX-2 inhibitors reduce pain and inflammation but may have cardiovascular, renal, and gastrointestinal risks.

COX-2 Inhibitors

Medicines that reduce the action of an enzyme involved in pain and inflammation. They may cause less stomach irritation than some older anti-inflammatory medicines, but can still cause bleeding, kidney problems, high blood pressure, or heart risks.

Alternate Names:
Cyclooxygenase-2 Inhibitors; Selective COX-2 Inhibitors

Coxalgia

Pain arising from the hip or nearby tissues, often felt in the groin and sometimes spreading to the thigh or knee. Causes vary with age and include infection, injury, growth problems, arthritis, cartilage damage, stress fractures, and reduced blood supply.

Coxa Vara

A hip deformity in which the upper thigh bone has an unusually narrow angle, making the leg shorter or changing how the hip bears weight. It may cause a limp, pain, or limited movement.

Coxiella Burnetii

A bacterium that causes Q fever, usually spread by breathing dust contaminated by infected farm animals. It can cause fever, headache, hepatitis, or pneumonia and may persist as a serious infection of heart valves.

Coxsackie

Alternate name; see *Coxsackievirus*.

Coxsackievirus

A group of viruses that can cause fever, sore throat, mouth sores, rashes, or hand, foot, and mouth disease. Some types can also inflame the heart, its surrounding sac, the muscles, or the coverings of the brain.

Coxsackie Virus Type A16

A virus that commonly causes hand, foot, and mouth disease, especially in children. Fever, painful mouth sores, and a rash or blisters on the hands and feet usually resolve without serious complications.

Cozen Test

A physical examination manoeuvre used to assess for lateral epicondylitis (tennis elbow). The patient extends and radially deviates the wrist against examiner resistance while the elbow is stabilized in flexion; sharp pain at the lateral epicondyle constitutes a positive finding.

Alternate Names:
Cozen's Test; Tennis Elbow Test

CP

A commonly used abbreviation for cerebral palsy, a group of permanent disorders of movement and posture caused by injury or abnormal development of the developing brain. Associated problems may involve sensation, communication, cognition, seizures, or feeding.

CPAP

Continuous positive airway pressure delivered through a mask to splint open the upper airway during sleep. It is commonly used for obstructive sleep apnea and can reduce apneas and related symptoms when used consistently.

CPAP Machine

A device that sends a steady stream of air through a mask to keep the upper airway open during sleep. It is commonly used for obstructive sleep apnea;

benefit depends on correct mask fit and regular use.

C-Peptide

A small protein fragment released when the pancreas makes insulin. Measuring it helps show how much insulin a person's body is making, rather than how much injected insulin is present. Kidney function and blood-glucose levels can affect the result.

CpG

A DNA sequence in which cytosine is followed by guanine on the same strand, often occurring in regions whose methylation helps regulate gene expression.

CPK Isoenzymes Test

A blood test that separates forms of creatine kinase to help identify whether an increased level comes mainly from skeletal muscle, heart muscle, or brain. Troponin testing is usually preferred when a heart attack is suspected.

CPR

Alternate index label; see *Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation*.

CPVT

Alternate name; see *Catecholaminergic Polymorphic Ventricular Tachycardia*.

Crabs

Alternate colloquial name; see *Pubic Lice*.

Crabs (Pubic Lice)

Infestation of coarse body hair by pubic lice, causing itching and visible nits or lice. It is usually sexually transmitted but can spread through close contact; other sexually transmitted infections may coexist.

Cracked Heels

Dry, thickened skin at the heel that develops fissures, sometimes deep enough to bleed or become infected. Moisturizers, gentle filing, and treatment of contributing skin disease can help; painful or infected cracks may have complications.

Cracked Tooth Syndrome

A partial crack in a tooth that may cause sharp pain when biting or when pressure is released, and sensitivity to hot or cold. The crack can be difficult to locate and may worsen over time. Dental treatment depends on its depth and whether the inner pulp is involved.

Crackles

Brief popping or bubbling sounds heard in the lungs, usually while breathing in. They may occur when small airways reopen or when air moves through fluid, as in pneumonia, heart failure, or scarring.

Alternate Names:
Rales

Cradle Cap

A common form of seborrheic dermatitis in infants, causing greasy or flaky scales on the scalp with mild redness. It is usually harmless and often resolves spontaneously; persistent inflammation or signs of infection may indicate another condition.

Cramp

A sudden, involuntary, often painful muscle contraction. Cramps may result from exertion, dehydration, electrolyte changes, pregnancy, medicines, nerve disease, or reduced blood flow.

Cramping Leg Pain

Pain caused by involuntary, often painful muscle contraction in the leg; contributors include exertion, dehydration, electrolyte abnormalities, medications, nerve disease, and impaired circulation.

Cramps But No Period

Pelvic cramps without menstruation can result from ovulation, pregnancy, implantation, constipation, urinary disease, infection, endometriosis, cysts, or other pelvic conditions. Severe one-sided pain, faintness, fever, or vomiting may accompany serious causes, including ectopic pregnancy.

Cranberries

Red fruits containing fiber and plant compounds.

Cranberry products may modestly reduce recurrent urinary infections in some people but do not treat an established infection; they can interact with warfarin and other medicines.

Cranial

Relating to the skull or toward the head, as opposed to caudal or toward the lower end of the body.

Cranial Arteritis

Inflammation of arteries, usually in the scalp and head, that can cause a new headache, scalp tenderness, jaw pain while chewing, fever, or vision loss. Sudden visual symptoms require emergency treatment.

Cranial Cavity

The hollow space inside the skull that contains and protects the brain, its coverings, blood vessels, and cerebrospinal fluid. A rise in pressure inside this space can compress the brain and become life-threatening.

Cranial Fasciitis

A usually harmless but rapidly growing lump in the scalp or nearby soft tissue, most often in infants and young children. It can look like cancer on examination or scans, so a tissue sample may be needed to confirm the diagnosis.

Cranial Implant

An artificial material or device placed in or on the skull to repair a defect, protect the brain, drain fluid, stimulate nerves, or support treatment. Risks include infection, bleeding, and implant failure.

Cranial Mononeuropathy III

Damage to the third cranial nerve, which controls several eye muscles, the eyelid, and the pupil. It can cause double vision, a drooping eyelid, abnormal eye position, or an enlarged pupil.

Cranial Nerve

One of twelve pairs of peripheral nerves that arise directly from the brain and brainstem (rather than the spinal cord) and traverse dedicated cranial foramina of the skull base to provide sensory, motor, and autonomic parasympathetic innervation to the head, neck, and thoracoabdominal viscera. Numbered sequentially with Roman numerals I through XII: I (olfactory; special sensory), II (optic; special sensory), III (oculomotor; somatic motor/parasympathetic), IV (trochlear; somatic motor), V (trigeminal; branchial motor/somatic sensory), VI (abducens; somatic motor), VII (facial; mixed/parasympathetic), VIII (vestibulocochlear; special sensory), IX (glossopharyngeal; mixed/parasympathetic), X (vagus; mixed/parasympathetic), XI (accessory; branchial motor), and XII (hypoglossal; somatic motor).

Cranial Nerve Palsy

Weakness or loss of function caused by injury or dysfunction of one or more cranial nerves or their nuclei in the brain. It may cause double vision, facial weakness, hearing loss, trouble swallowing, or tongue weakness, depending on the nerve involved.

Alternate Names:
Cranial Nerve Paralysis

Cranial Nerves

Plural form; see *Cranial Nerve*.

Cranial Nerve X

The vagus nerve, the tenth cranial nerve, which carries parasympathetic and sensory fibers and contributes to swallowing, voice, and regulation of thoracic and abdominal organs.

Cranial Sutures

Fibrous joints between skull bones that permit molding in infancy and accommodate brain growth before progressively fusing; premature fusion causes craniosynostosis.

Craniectomy

An operation in which part of the skull is removed and left off temporarily, often to give a swollen brain more room. It may be done after a serious head injury, stroke, or brain bleed. The skull opening is usually repaired later with the saved bone or an artificial piece.

Alternate Names:
Decompressive Craniectomy; Hemicraniectomy; Suboccipital Craniectomy

Craniocerebral Injury

An injury involving the scalp, skull, brain, or several of these structures, ranging from minor wounds to life-threatening traumatic brain injury.

Craniofacial

Relating to the skull and face. Craniofacial conditions may involve bones, soft tissues, teeth, eyes, ears, or airway and may be congenital, traumatic, developmental, or acquired.

Craniofacial Abnormalities

Abnormalities of the skull, face, or related tissues that may be present at birth or develop later. Causes include genetic conditions, disrupted development, trauma, infection, and tumors.

Craniofacial Disorder

A condition that affects the skull, face, jaw, or nearby soft tissues. It may be present at birth or develop later. Examples include cleft lip and palate and early joining of skull bones. Depending on the condition, it can affect breathing, feeding, hearing, vision, teeth, or speech.

Alternate Names:
Craniofacial Anomaly; Craniofacial Malformation; Craniofacial Condition

Craniofacial Dysostosis

A birth disorder in which some skull bones join too early and the face develops unusually. It can change head shape, affect the eyes or airway, and sometimes increase pressure around the brain; severity varies.

Craniofacial Microsomia

A birth condition in which one side of the face develops less fully than the other. It may affect the jaw, ear, eye, facial muscles, and nearby tissues, with severity ranging from mild to complex.

Craniofacial Surgery

Surgery to correct congenital, traumatic, developmental, or acquired conditions of the skull, face, jaws, and associated soft tissues. Care often involves collaboration among plastic, oral and maxillofacial, neurosurgical, and other specialties.

Craniopharyngioma

A usually slow-growing tumor near the pituitary gland and hypothalamus. It may cause headache, vision loss, excessive thirst or urination, hormone problems, growth changes, or increased pressure in the skull.

Cranioplasty

Surgery to repair a missing or damaged part of the skull, often after a head injury or earlier brain surgery. A stored piece of bone or an artificial material may be used. It protects the brain and may improve skull shape or symptoms, but results and risks vary.

Alternate Names:
Skull Reconstruction; Cranial Reconstruction; Skull Defect Repair

Craniorachischisis

A severe neural tube defect in which the skull and spine fail to close along an extensive portion of their length, leaving the brain and spinal cord exposed to varying degrees. It combines features of anencephaly and open spina bifida and is usually incompatible with long-term survival. The condition is diagnosed by prenatal imaging or examination after birth.

Craniosynostosis

Craniosynostosis is premature fusion of one or more skull sutures, altering head shape and sometimes increasing pressure on the developing brain.

Alternate Names:
Craniostenosis

Craniosynostosis Repair

Surgery to separate prematurely fused skull bones and reshape the skull when needed. It aims to improve head shape and make room for brain growth; timing and technique depend on the child's age and

anatomy.

Craniotabes

Soft areas of an infant's skull that bend or indent more easily than expected. They can be part of normal newborn molding but may also result from rickets or another bone disorder; significance varies with the baby's examination and growth.

Craniotomy

An operation in which a surgeon temporarily removes a piece of the skull to reach the brain or its coverings. It may be used to remove a tumor, stop bleeding, repair an aneurysm, or treat another brain problem. The bone is usually put back and secured at the end of the operation.

Alternate Names:
Open Brain Surgery; Bone Flap Surgery; Craniotomy Bone Flap

Cranium

The part of the skull that encloses and protects the brain, consisting of the cranial bones and their joints.

Crapulence

An unpleasant state of sickness or discomfort caused by excessive eating or drinking, especially excessive alcohol use.

Craving

A strong, often difficult-to-control desire for a substance, behavior, or experience, commonly seen in substance-use disorders.

Alternate Names:
Strong Urge; Compulsive Desire

Crazy Paving Pattern

A lung-imaging pattern of hazy areas crossed by thick lines, resembling paving stones. It can occur with several conditions, including infection, bleeding, inflammation, or protein buildup, so it is not a diagnosis by itself.

CRC

Colorectal cancer, malignant disease arising in the colon or rectum; screening and evaluation depend on age, risk, symptoms, and test results.

CRE

Enterobacterales bacteria resistant to carbapenem antibiotics, important medicines for serious infections. They may colonize without illness or cause difficult-to-treat urinary, wound, abdominal, lung, or bloodstream infections.

C-Reactive Protein

A protein made by the liver that rises when there is inflammation or infection. It can help monitor inflammatory diseases and possible infection, but it does not identify the cause by itself. A high-sensitivity CRP test may be used with other information to assess heart-disease risk.

C-Reactive Protein Test

A blood test that measures C-reactive protein. The level may rise with inflammation or infection, but the test cannot identify the cause by itself; levels are considered with symptoms and other findings.

Cream

A spreadable semisolid preparation applied to the skin, often containing a medicine. Creams are usually less greasy than ointments and may be useful on moist or broad areas, but the correct product depends on the skin condition.

Creatine

A nitrogen-containing compound stored mainly in skeletal muscle that helps supply energy for short, high-intensity activity.

Creatine Kinase

An enzyme found mainly in muscle and released into blood when muscle cells are damaged. Levels may rise after strenuous exercise, injury, seizures, muscle disease, or some medicines; other tests help identify the source.

Creatine Kinase Test

A blood test measuring creatine kinase, an enzyme released into circulation following injury to muscle tissues, the myocardium, or the brain; see *Creatine Kinase*.

Creatine Phosphokinase Test

A blood test measuring creatine kinase, an enzyme released with muscle injury; elevated levels may occur in skeletal-muscle disease, strenuous exercise, rhabdomyolysis, or myocardial injury.

Creating A Family Health History

Collecting a record of relatives' diseases, ages at diagnosis, ancestry, and causes of death to identify inherited risk and guide screening, prevention, and genetic counseling.

Creatinine

A breakdown product of muscle creatine phosphate produced at a constant rate, filtered by the glomerulus and minimally reabsorbed; serum creatinine is the most used marker of kidney function.

Creatinine Blood Test

A blood test measuring serum creatinine, a waste product generated largely by skeletal muscle. It is used with age, body size, and other factors to estimate kidney filtration, but interpretation is affected by muscle mass, diet, medicines, and acute illness.

Creatinine Clearance Test

A test estimating kidney filtration from creatinine in a timed urine collection and blood sample. It can be affected by incomplete urine collection and creatinine secretion, so estimated glomerular filtration rate is often preferred for routine assessment.

Creatinine Test

A blood or urine test measuring creatinine to help assess kidney filtration and muscle-related creatinine production.

Alternate Names:
Creatinine Measurement; Renal Function Creatinine Test

Creatinine Urine Test

A urine test measuring creatinine concentration or excretion, used to assess kidney handling, interpret other urine measurements, or judge the completeness of a timed collection. Results depend on muscle mass, diet, collection quality, and kidney function.

Creeping Eruption

An intensely itchy winding skin track caused by larvae, usually hookworms from contaminated soil or sand, migrating within the superficial skin.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Larva Migrans

CRE Infection

An infection caused by carbapenem-resistant Enterobacterales, bacteria resistant to carbapenem antibiotics. Infection may involve the urinary tract, blood, abdomen, wounds, or lungs. Detection of CRE without attributable illness is colonization, not infection.

Cremasteric Reflex

A superficial neurological reflex elicited by lightly stroking or scratching the superior and medial aspect of the inner thigh, causing prompt contraction of the cremaster muscle and upward retraction of the ipsilateral testis, mediated through spinal cord segments L1 and L2 via the genitofemoral and ilioinguinal nerves.

Alternate Names:
Cremaster Reflex; Genitofemoral Reflex

Crepitation

Alternate name; see *Crepitus*.

Crepitus

A crackling, grating, or popping sensation or sound caused by movement of tissue, bone, joint surfaces, or air in soft tissue.

Alternate Names:
Crackling Sensation

Crescentic Glomerulonephritis

A rapidly worsening inflammation of the kidney's

filtering units. It can cause blood or protein in urine, swelling, high blood pressure, and kidney failure.

CREST Syndrome

A limited cutaneous form of systemic sclerosis named for Calcinosis, Raynaud phenomenon, Esophageal dysfunction, Sclerodactyly, and Telangiectasia. It may also affect the lungs, heart, kidneys, or digestive tract; monitoring for pulmonary hypertension and other organ involvement is important.

Creutzfeld-Jakob Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease*.

Creutzfeldt Jakob Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease*.

Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease

A rare brain disease caused by abnormal proteins called prions that damage brain cells. It usually worsens quickly and can affect memory, thinking, movement, balance, and coordination. It is fatal. It causes worsening cognitive impairment and may produce myoclonus, ataxia, visual changes, or other neurologic signs. Most cases are sporadic; others are genetic or rarely acquired. Variant CJD, linked to bovine spongiform encephalopathy, is a distinct form.

CRIA Syndrome

A rare inherited inflammatory disorder caused by a change in the RIPK1 gene. Repeated attacks of fever, swollen lymph nodes, muscle or joint pain, and inflammation often begin during childhood.

Crib Death

Alternate name; see *Sudden Infant Death Syndrome*.

Cribriform

Having multiple small openings in a sieve-like arrangement. In pathology, the term describes a tissue or tumour growth pattern; its significance depends on the organ and tumour type.

Cribriform Carcinoma

A carcinoma with a sieve-like microscopic growth pattern. The term may describe several tumors, including adenoid cystic carcinoma or cribriform breast carcinoma, so the organ of origin and pathology report determine its meaning.

Cribriform Plate

The horizontal, sieve-like bony lamina of the ethmoid bone situated in the floor of the anterior cranial fossa, perforated by numerous small foramina transmitting the olfactory nerve (CN I) fascicles from the nasal olfactory mucosa into the anterior cranial cavity.

Cricoid Cartilage

A complete ring of firm tissue at the lower part of the voice box, just above the windpipe. It supports the airway and connects with other structures involved in breathing and voice.

Cricoid Pressure

Pressure applied to the cricoid cartilage during some emergency airway procedures. Its use is intended to reduce stomach contents entering the airway, but it can make ventilation or intubation more difficult and is clinician-dependent.

Cricothyroid Membrane

A tough fibroelastic ligament located in the anterior neck between the inferior border of the thyroid cartilage and the superior border of the cricoid cartilage; the target anatomical landmark for emergency airway cricothyroidotomy.

Alternate Names:
Cricothyroid Ligament; Conus Elasticus

Cricothyroidotomy

An emergency surgical airway procedure in which an incisional opening is made through the skin and cricothyroid membrane to introduce an endotracheal or tracheostomy tube, indicated in catastrophic "cannot intubate, cannot ventilate" scenarios.

Alternate Names:
Cricothyroidectomy; Emergency Surgical Airway

Cricothyrotomy

An emergency operation creating an opening through the front of the neck into the airway when a person cannot be intubated or oxygenated by other means. It provides temporary access for breathing and has serious risks.

Cri Du Chat Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Cri-Du-Chat Syndrome*.

Cri-Du-Chat Syndrome

A chromosomal condition caused by deletion of part of the short arm of chromosome 5 (5p-). The size of the deletion varies and contributes to the range of features. Infants often have a high-pitched, cat-like cry, low muscle tone, low birth weight, and a small head; affected people may have distinctive facial features, intellectual disability, and developmental delay. Some have congenital heart defects. Most cases arise spontaneously; a minority result from an inherited chromosome rearrangement.

Alternate Names:
Cat Cry Syndrome; 5p Deletion Syndrome; 5p- Syndrome; Monosomy 5p; Chromosome 5p Deletion Syndrome

Crigler-Najjar Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which the liver cannot properly process bilirubin. It causes persistent yellowing of the skin and eyes; severe forms can damage the brain unless treated urgently.

Crimean-Congo Hemorrhagic Fever

A serious viral illness usually spread by infected ticks or contact with infected animal blood. It can also spread through the blood or body fluids of an infected person. Symptoms may include sudden fever, headache, muscle pain, vomiting, or diarrhea. Severe illness can cause bleeding, organ failure, or shock.

Crime Scene Investigation

The systematic documentation, collection, preservation, and analysis of physical evidence from a suspected crime scene, often supporting forensic medical and legal conclusions.

Criminal Abortion

Abortion performed illegally, outside permitted legal indications and procedures (e.g., unsafe methods, unqualified practitioners, or non-medical settings), carrying high maternal risk.

CRISPR

A gene-editing method that uses a guide molecule and an enzyme to find and change a chosen DNA sequence. It is used in research and some treatments but can make unintended changes and requires careful monitoring.

CRISPR-Cas9

A laboratory gene-editing tool that uses a guide molecule to direct an enzyme to a chosen DNA sequence. The enzyme cuts the DNA so the cell can remove, disable, or replace genetic material.

CRISPR Therapy

A treatment that uses CRISPR-based genome-editing tools to make a targeted change to DNA in a patient's cells. Cells may be edited outside the body and returned to the patient, or edited directly inside the body. It is used or studied for selected genetic and other diseases; possible concerns include unintended genetic changes, immune reactions, and effects that require long-term monitoring.

Crisscross Heart

A rare congenital heart malformation in which the inflow streams to the right and left ventricles cross because the ventricular mass is abnormally rotated around its long axis. The atrioventricular connections themselves may be structurally normal, but other heart defects can coexist. Echocardiography and other cardiac imaging define the anatomy and its relationship to the other cardiac abnormalities.

Crista Galli

A vertical, crest-like bony projection of the ethmoid bone rising upward from the cribriform plate into the anterior cranial fossa, serving as the anterior intracranial attachment site for the falx cerebri.

Critical Care

Specialized care for people with life-threatening illness or injury who need close monitoring and support for failing organs.

Critical Care Nursing

Specialized nursing care for critically ill patients requiring close monitoring, organ support, rapid assessment, complex therapies, and coordination with multidisciplinary intensive-care teams.

Critical Findings

Test or examination findings that may indicate a life-threatening problem. Examples include a collapsed lung, brain pressure, or a tear in the aorta.

Critical Illness Myopathy

A muscle weakness disorder that develops during severe illness, especially sepsis, organ failure, prolonged intensive-care treatment, or use of certain medicines. It can affect arms, legs, and breathing muscles, making movement and removal from a ventilator difficult. Rehabilitation supports recovery.

Alternate Names:
CIM; Acute Quadriplegic Myopathy; Critical Care Myopathy

Critical Illness Polyneuropathy

Damage to many peripheral nerves that can develop during severe critical illness, especially sepsis or multiorgan failure. It causes weakness, reduced reflexes, and difficulty coming off a ventilator and may occur together with critical illness myopathy.

Critical Illness-Related Corticosteroid Insufficiency

Inadequate corticosteroid activity during critical illness, caused by impaired adrenal production, altered hormone metabolism, or reduced tissue response. It may contribute to low blood pressure, shock, inflammation, or poor response to usual supportive care.

Critical Limb Ischemia

Older term; see *Chronic Limb-Threatening Ischemia*.

Critical Results

Test findings suggesting a potentially life-threatening problem that are communicated promptly to the responsible healthcare team.

Critical Value

A laboratory result indicating a potentially life-threatening condition that requires communication to a responsible clinician or care team. The threshold is test- and laboratory-specific and defined by institutional policy.

Crohn Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Crohn's Disease*.

Crohn Disease Cobblestoning

A bumpy appearance of the bowel lining seen during an internal examination in some people with Crohn disease. Deep ulcers surround areas of less-inflamed tissue, creating a pattern resembling cobblestones.

Crohn Disease Pathology

Patchy, chronic, often transmural intestinal inflammation with architectural distortion, fissures, creeping fat, and possible noncaseating granulomas. The disease may involve any part of the gastrointestinal tract and commonly produces skip lesions.

Crohn Ileitis

Crohn disease involving the ileum, the final part of the small intestine, causing chronic or relapsing inflammation that may produce abdominal pain, diarrhea, weight loss, strictures, or fistulas.

Crohn Ileocolitis

Crohn disease affecting both the ileum and colon, causing patchy chronic inflammation that may lead to abdominal pain, diarrhea, weight loss, strictures, fistulas, or perianal disease.

Crohn's Disease

A chronic inflammatory bowel disease that causes ongoing inflammation deep in the digestive tract

lining. It can affect any part of the digestive system from the mouth to the anus, but most commonly involves the lower part of the small intestine (ileum) and the colon. The inflammation often penetrates all layers of the bowel wall in scattered patches ('skip lesions'), causing abdominal pain, persistent diarrhea, cramping, weight loss, and potentially narrowing the bowel or creating abnormal tunnels called fistulas.

Alternate Names:
Regional Enteritis; Granulomatous Enteritis; Crohn's; Crohn Disease

Cronkhite-Canada Syndrome

A rare, non-familial gastrointestinal polyposis syndrome characterized by multiple juvenile-like hamartomatous polyps throughout the stomach, small bowel, and colon, accompanied by distinctive ectodermal changes including generalized alopecia, cutaneous hyperpigmentation, and dystrophic onycholysis.

Alternate Names:
CCS; Gastrointestinal Polyposis with Ectodermal Changes

Crossed Extensor Reflex

A contralateral polysynaptic spinal reflex in which noxious or painful stimulation causing flexion and withdrawal of an injured limb simultaneously triggers contraction of extensor muscles and inhibition of flexor muscles in the opposite limb to maintain upright balance and posture.

Alternate Names:
Crossed Extension Reflex; Contralateral Extensor Reflex

Cross-Eyes (Strabismus)

Misalignment of the eyes so they do not point in the same direction. Persistent strabismus in a child can impair visual development and cause amblyopia; sudden adult onset may indicate neurologic or ocular disease.

Crossmatch

Laboratory test mixing donor and recipient blood to detect preformed antibodies that could cause transfusion or transplant reactions.

Cross-Matching

Laboratory testing that checks whether donor blood is compatible with a recipient before transfusion. It helps prevent dangerous immune reactions by detecting antibodies that could attack transfused red cells.

Cross-Section

A slice or plane made through a structure, or an image showing that slice, such as a cross-sectional CT image.

Cross-Sectional Study

A study that measures possible causes and health outcomes at one point in time. It can show how common a condition is and whether factors are linked, but it usually cannot show which came first or prove cause and effect.

Cross-Tolerance

Reduced response to one substance because the body has adapted to another substance with a similar effect. It can increase overdose risk when a person changes substances or combines them.

Crosti-Gianotti Syndrome

A self-limited papular rash of childhood, also called papular acrodermatitis of childhood. It may follow viral infection or vaccination and causes symmetric papules on the face, buttocks, and limbs, usually resolving over weeks.

Crotch

The region where the inner thighs meet the trunk, including the groin and nearby perineal structures.

Croup

A usually viral illness in babies and young children that swells the voice box and windpipe. The swelling can narrow the airway, causing a barking cough, a hoarse voice, and sometimes a harsh, high-pitched sound when breathing in.

Alternate Names:

Acute Laryngotracheitis

Crouzon Syndrome

A craniosynostosis syndrome, usually caused by a pathogenic *FGFR2* variant, in which skull sutures fuse too early. It changes the shape of the skull and face and may cause shallow eye sockets, vision problems, airway obstruction, dental abnormalities, hearing loss, or raised pressure around the brain.

Crowe Sign

Small freckles in the armpits or groin. They are one finding that can support neurofibromatosis type 1, but they are not enough to make the diagnosis alone.

Alternate Names:
Crowe's Sign; Axillary Freckling Sign

Crow-Fukase Syndrome

Another name for POEMS syndrome, a rare plasma-cell disorder associated with polyneuropathy, organ enlargement, endocrinopathy, monoclonal protein, and characteristic skin changes.

Crown

The visible part of a tooth above the gum line, or a dental restoration that covers and protects a damaged tooth.

Alternate Names:
Dental Crown; Anatomic Tooth Crown

Crowning

The stage of childbirth when the baby's head remains visible at the vaginal opening between contractions because it has stretched the surrounding tissues. It occurs shortly before the head is born.

Crown Lengthening

A dental procedure that removes or reshapes gum tissue, and sometimes a small amount of bone, to expose more tooth. It may allow a damaged tooth to be restored or change a gummy smile.

Crown-Rump Length

The ultrasound measurement from the top of an embryo's head to its bottom. It is the most accurate way to estimate pregnancy age during early pregnancy and helps monitor early growth.

CRP

C-reactive protein, a substance made by the liver that rises during inflammation or infection. A CRP test can help assess inflammation and response to treatment, but it does not identify the cause by itself.

Cruciate Ligament

One of two strong bands crossing inside the knee that stabilize forward, backward, and twisting movement. The anterior cruciate ligament is commonly torn during sports or a sudden change in direction.

Crushing Injury

Damage caused when a body part is compressed between heavy objects. It can produce fractures, nerve and blood-vessel injury, tissue death, and rhabdomyolysis. Severe limb compression or sudden release after prolonged entrapment requires emergency treatment.

Crush Injury

Damage caused when a body part is squeezed or trapped under pressure. It can cause broken bones, muscle death, nerve and vessel injury, dangerous chemical changes in blood, shock, or kidney failure.

Crush Syndrome

A life-threatening illness after prolonged muscle compression, often when someone is trapped. Damaged muscle releases substances that can cause shock, dangerous heart rhythms, and sudden kidney failure, especially after pressure is removed.

Crust

Dried serum, blood, pus, or other exudate on the skin surface, often covering an erosion, ulcer, vesicle, pustule, or inflamed lesion.

Crusted Scabies

A severe form of scabies causing thick crusts full

of very large numbers of mites. It is extremely contagious and occurs mainly in people with weakened immunity, older adults, or people with reduced sensation.

Cruveilhier-Baumgarten Sign

A continuous epigastric or periumbilical vascular venous hum and palpable thrill resulting from turbulent collaterals in recanalized umbilical or paraumbilical veins in patients with severe portal hypertension and cirrhosis.

Alternate Names:
Cruveilhier-Baumgarten Murmur; Cruveilhier-Baumgarten Syndrome

Cry For Help

A verbal or behavioral expression of distress or need for assistance; in a mental-health setting it may reflect immediate safety concerns.

Crying In Childhood

Vocal expression of distress or emotion in a child; persistent, inconsolable, unusual, or pain-associated crying may indicate illness, injury, abuse, or unmet developmental needs.

Crying In Infancy

Crying is an infant's normal communication of hunger, discomfort, fatigue, or need for contact; sudden inconsolable crying with lethargy, fever, vomiting, or injury may indicate illness or injury.

Cryoablation

A treatment that uses controlled freezing to destroy selected abnormal tissue, such as a tumor or abnormal heart pathway. Imaging or specialized equipment guides the treatment, which may cause bleeding, injury, or recurrence.

Cryobiopsy

A biopsy method that uses a freezing instrument to remove a larger tissue sample, often from the lung. It can improve diagnosis in selected cases but carries risks such as bleeding and a collapsed lung.

Cryoglobulinemia

A condition in which abnormal blood proteins thicken or clump when cold. They can inflame small blood vessels and cause purplish skin spots, joint pain, nerve problems, kidney injury, or poor circulation.

Cryoglobulinemic Vasculitis

Inflammation and injury of small blood vessels caused by abnormal blood proteins that become active in the cold. It may cause purple spots, joint pain, nerve problems, kidney disease, or poor circulation.

Cryoglobulins

Immunoglobulins that precipitate at low temperatures and dissolve on warming; circulating cryoglobulins can cause vasculitis, purpura, neuropathy, kidney disease, or hyperviscosity.

Cryopexy

A procedure that uses controlled freezing to destroy or seal abnormal tissue, especially retinal breaks or small retinal detachments.

Cryoprecipitate

A blood-product concentrate containing mainly fibrinogen and some clotting proteins. It is given in selected serious bleeding disorders when a person's fibrinogen level is too low.

Cryopreservation

Preserving cells, tissues, sperm, eggs, or embryos by cooling them to very low temperatures with protective chemicals. The material can later be thawed for treatment, research, or reproduction.

Cryopyrin-Associated Autoinflammatory Syndromes

Alternate index label; see *Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndromes*; the group is also called CAPS.

Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndromes

A group of inherited inflammatory disorders causing

repeated fever, rash, joint symptoms, eye inflammation, or hearing loss because immune activity is overactive.

Cryostat

An instrument that maintains very low temperatures and cuts thin frozen sections of tissue for rapid microscopic examination.

Cryosurgery

Surgery that destroys abnormal tissue by controlled freezing, used in selected skin lesions, tumors, and other conditions.

Cryotherapy

Treatment using controlled cold to destroy or reduce abnormal tissue. It may treat selected skin lesions, tumors, eye problems, or prostate disease; pain, blistering, scarring, and damage to nearby tissue are possible.

Cryotherapy For Prostate Cancer

A treatment that destroys prostate tissue by repeated freezing and thawing, used selectively for localized or recurrent prostate cancer.

Cryotherapy For The Skin

Destruction of selected skin lesions by controlled freezing, usually with liquid nitrogen, for conditions such as warts, actinic keratoses, or some superficial tumors.

Crypt

A small cavity, gland, or recessed space in body tissue, such as an intestinal crypt or tonsillar crypt.

Cryptitis

Inflammation of a small gland or recessed space in body tissue, most often the tiny glands and spaces lining the anal canal. It may cause pain, bleeding, or discharge.

Crypto

Informal shorthand that can mean cryptococcosis, a fungal infection caused by *Cryptococcus*, or cryptosporidiosis, an intestinal infection caused by *Cryptosporidium*. The two infections are unrelated, so the shorthand is ambiguous.

Cryptococcal Infection

Alternate name; see *Cryptococcosis*.

Cryptococcal Meningitis

A fungal infection of the coverings and fluid around the brain, usually in people with weakened immunity. It often develops gradually with headache, fever, nausea, confusion, vision changes, or unusual sleepiness.

Alternate Names:
Cryptococcic Meningitis

Cryptococcic Meningitis

Meningitis caused by *Cryptococcus* fungi, especially in people with advanced HIV or other immune suppression. Headache, fever, confusion, nausea, and visual symptoms may develop gradually.

Cryptococcosis

Cryptococcosis is fungal infection caused by Cryptococcus, often affecting the lungs or brain in people with immune suppression.

Alternate Names:
Torulosis

Cryptococcus Neoformans

A yeast found in soil and bird droppings that can cause lung or brain infection after it is inhaled. Serious disease is most likely in people with weakened immunity and may require prolonged antifungal treatment.

Cryptogenic Organizing Pneumonia

Organizing pneumonia with no identified cause. Small plugs of healing tissue block air sacs and nearby airways, causing cough, fever, or shortness of breath. It is one form of organizing pneumonia, which can also occur after infection or with medicines and immune diseases.

Cryptomenorrhea

Menstrual bleeding that occurs but cannot leave the body because a blockage prevents flow through the vagina. It may cause monthly pelvic pain and a buildup of menstrual blood.

Cryptorchid

Describing a testis that has not descended into the scrotum. See also: *Cryptorchidism*.

Cryptorchidism

One or both testicles fail to move into or remain in the scrotum, the pouch of skin below the penis. Some move down on their own in early infancy; others remain in the groin or abdomen, or move back up after descending. The condition can reduce fertility and raises the risk of testicular cancer. Surgery to move a testicle into the scrotum is called orchiopexy and may reduce some risks.

Alternate Names:
Cryptorchism; Maldescended Testis

Cryptosporidiosis

An intestinal infection caused by microscopic Cryptosporidium parasites. It spreads when contaminated water, food, surfaces, or material from infected people or animals is swallowed. It may cause watery diarrhea, stomach cramps, nausea, and loss of fluids. Some people have no symptoms, while illness may be prolonged or severe in people with weakened immune systems.

Cryptosporidium Enteritis

Diarrheal intestinal infection caused by Cryptosporidium parasites, transmitted through contaminated water, food, or contact; illness can be prolonged or severe in immunocompromised people.

Crystal Arthropathy

Joint inflammation caused by crystals collecting in or around a joint. Uric-acid crystals cause gout, while calcium-pyrophosphate crystals cause pseudogout; sudden pain, swelling, warmth, and redness are common, and joint-fluid testing can confirm the cause.

Crystal-Induced Synovitis

Acute or chronic joint inflammation caused by deposition of crystals such as monosodium urate, calcium pyrophosphate, or basic calcium phosphate in or around the joint.

Crystalline Lens

The clear, flexible structure inside the eye that focuses light onto the retina. It changes shape for near vision and becomes cloudy in cataracts, causing blurred or reduced vision.

Crystalloids

Sterile fluids containing water and small dissolved substances such as salts or sugar. They can be given through a vein to replace lost fluid, but the choice and amount depend on the person's condition.

Crystalluria

The presence of crystals in urine, which may reflect precipitation of salts, medication effects, metabolic disease, or a tendency to form urinary stones.

C-Section

Alternate index label; see *Cesarean Section*.

CSF Analysis

Alternate name; see *Cerebrospinal Fluid Analysis*.

CSF Cell Count

Laboratory measurement of red and white blood cells in cerebrospinal fluid, used to evaluate meningitis, encephalitis, subarachnoid hemorrhage, inflammation, malignancy, and other central nervous system disorders.

CSF Coccidioides Complement Fixation Test

A cerebrospinal-fluid test for complement-fixing antibodies to Coccidioides, used with other findings to evaluate suspected coccidioidal meningitis.

CSF Glucose Test

A laboratory measurement of glucose in cerebrospinal fluid, usually interpreted with a simulta-

neous blood-glucose value. Low cerebrospinal-fluid glucose may occur in bacterial, fungal, or tuberculous meningitis and other disorders, but results require the complete clinical and cerebrospinal-fluid profile.

CSF Leak

Escape of cerebrospinal fluid through a defect in the skull base or spinal dura, causing positional headache, clear nasal or ear drainage, wound leakage, meningitis risk, or intracranial hypotension.

CSF Myelin Basic Protein

A test measuring a protein released when the insulating covering of nerve fibers is damaged. An increased level may support evaluation of multiple sclerosis or other nervous-system injury but is not specific by itself.

CSF Oligoclonal Banding

A laboratory test looking for immune-protein bands in the fluid around the brain and spinal cord and comparing them with blood. The pattern may support multiple sclerosis or another inflammatory nervous-system disorder but is not diagnostic by itself.

CSF Rhinorrhea

Leakage of the fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord through a skull-base defect into the nose. It may cause a persistent clear, watery drip, often worse when bending forward, and can increase the risk of meningitis.

CSF Smear

Microscopic examination of cerebrospinal fluid for cells, organisms, or abnormal material, supporting evaluation of meningitis, hemorrhage, malignancy, or inflammation.

CSF Total Protein

A measurement of protein in cerebrospinal fluid, usually obtained by lumbar puncture. High or low levels may support evaluation of infection, bleeding, inflammation, nerve disorders, or other brain and spinal-cord disease.

CSF-VDRL Test

A test of the fluid around the brain and spinal cord for antibodies associated with syphilis. A positive result strongly supports neurosyphilis, but a negative result does not completely exclude it; symptoms and other tests contribute to interpretation.

CT

Computed tomography, an imaging method that uses multiple X-ray measurements and computer reconstruction to produce cross-sectional images.

Alternate Names:
Computed Tomography

CT Angiography

A CT scan performed after injected contrast highlights blood vessels. It can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, dissection, bleeding, or abnormal vessel connections in areas such as the brain, heart, chest, abdomen, or limbs.

CT Angiography – Chest

Computed tomography angiography of the chest uses intravenous contrast and computed tomography to visualize the thoracic aorta, pulmonary arteries, or other chest vessels. It can evaluate embolism, aneurysm, dissection, bleeding, and vascular malformation.

CT Angiography of Abdomen and Pelvis

High-resolution contrast-enhanced computed tomography optimized for vascular visualization of the abdominal aorta, visceral branches, renal arteries, and iliac vessels to diagnose aneurysms, dissections, mesenteric ischemia, and hemorrhage.

Alternate Names:
CTA Abdomen and Pelvis; Abdominal CT Angiography; Mesenteric CTA

CT Angiography of Head and Neck

Rapid contrast-enhanced computed tomographic angiography evaluating the extracranial carotid/vertebral arteries and intracranial cerebral arterial circulation in acute ischemic stroke, intracranial aneurysms, and vascular dissections.

Alternate Names:
CTA Head and Neck; Carotid CTA; Cerebral CT Angiography; Intracranial CTA

CT Angiography of the Extremities

Non-invasive contrast-enhanced computed tomographic imaging of upper or lower extremity arterial vasculature to assess peripheral arterial disease, traumatic vascular disruption, arterial emboli, or bypass graft patency.

Alternate Names:
CTA Extremities; Peripheral CTA; Runoff CTA; Lower Extremity CTA

CT Chest

A CT scan of the chest that shows the lungs, heart, blood vessels, mediastinum, pleura, ribs, and chest wall. It can evaluate infection, tumors, injury, fluid, blood clots, and other abnormalities.

CT Colonography

A CT scan of the colon after bowel cleansing and gentle inflation with air or carbon dioxide. It can look for polyps or cancer when colonoscopy is incomplete or unsuitable, but an abnormal result usually requires colonoscopy for tissue removal or biopsy.

Alternate Names:
Virtual Colonoscopy

CT Contrast

A substance administered during computed tomography to make selected tissues, vessels, or body spaces more visible.

CT Coronary Angiography

A CT scan taken after injected contrast outlines the arteries supplying the heart. It can show plaque or narrowing and is a non-invasive option for selected people with possible coronary artery disease.

CTD-Associated Interstitial Lung Disease

Interstitial lung disease occurring with autoimmune connective-tissue disease such as systemic sclerosis, rheumatoid arthritis, myositis, or Sjögren disease. Symptoms, lung function, high-resolution CT, antibodies, and disease activity guide monitoring and immunomodulatory or antifibrotic treatment.

CT Dose-Length Product

A measure of the radiation output from a CT scan that combines the scan settings with the length of the body examined. It helps imaging teams compare and improve protocols but does not directly predict one person's cancer risk.

Ctenocephalides Flea Bite

Alternate name; see *Flea Bites In Humans*.

CT Enterography

A CT scan of the small intestine after drinking contrast to expand the bowel and receiving injected contrast. It helps evaluate Crohn disease, inflammation, tumors, obstruction, and unexplained intestinal bleeding.

CTL

Cytotoxic T lymphocyte, an immune cell that recognizes and kills infected, abnormal, or target cells through antigen-specific mechanisms.

CTLA-4

A protein on some immune cells that acts as a brake on T-cell activity. Blocking this brake can strengthen an immune attack against cancer but may also cause inflammation in healthy organs.

CTPA

Alternate name; see *Computed Tomography Pulmonary Angiography*.

CT Perfusion

A CT technique that estimates blood flow and related perfusion parameters in tissue, commonly to assess selected cases of acute stroke or tumors.

CT Pulmonary Angiography

CT imaging performed after intravenous contrast to show the pulmonary arteries and evaluate suspected pulmonary embolism or other vascular abnormalities.

CTS

Commonly, carpal tunnel syndrome: compression of the median nerve at the wrist causing numbness, tingling, pain, or weakness in the hand.

CT Scan

An imaging test that uses rotating X-rays and a computer to create detailed cross-sectional pictures (slices) of the body. By taking pictures from multiple angles, it provides far more detail than a standard flat X-ray, quickly showing bones, internal bleeding, blood clots, organ injuries, and tumors. Scans can be done plain or with a contrast dye swallowed or injected into a vein to highlight blood vessels and internal organs.

Alternate Names:
Computed Tomography

Cubital

Relating to the elbow or nearby forearm. Cubital structures include the joint, bones, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels, and problems there may cause pain, restricted movement, numbness, or weakness.

Cubital Tunnel Syndrome

Pressure or stretching of the ulnar nerve at the elbow, causing tingling or numbness in the little and ring fingers, hand weakness, or pain. Symptoms often worsen when the elbow stays bent.

Cubitus

The elbow or the forearm; the term is also used in names of structures and conditions around the elbow.

Cubitus Valgus

An outward angle of the forearm at the elbow that is larger than usual when the arm is straight. It may be present from birth or develop after an elbow injury. In some people, it can put pressure on the ulnar nerve and cause tingling, numbness, or weakness in the ring and little fingers.

Cubitus Varus

An abnormal inward angulation of the forearm relative to the upper arm when the elbow is extended, often developing after a childhood elbow fracture.

Cuboid

A cube-shaped bone on the outer side of the midfoot. It helps form the foot arch and connects several foot bones; injury or displacement can cause outer-foot pain, especially during walking.

Cul-De-Sac

A space or pouch that ends without an opening on the other side. In the pelvis, it may refer to the space behind the uterus or between the bladder and rectum.

Culdocentesis

A procedure that places a needle through the back of the vagina to sample or drain fluid from the lowest part of the pelvis. Ultrasound and less-invasive tests have replaced it in many situations.

Cullen Sign

Bluish bruising in the skin around the belly button, which suggests bleeding inside the abdomen or severe inflammation of the pancreas.

Cullen's Sign

Blue or purple discoloration around the navel caused by blood leaking into tissues inside the abdomen and tracking to the skin. It can signal serious internal bleeding, including bleeding from severe pancreatitis or pregnancy-related emergencies.

Cultural Psychiatry

The study and clinical practice of how cultural factors influence mental health, illness expression, diagnosis, and treatment. Cultural concepts of distress, idioms of distress, and cultural syndromes must be considered. The DSM-5 includes a Cultural Formulation Interview.

Culture

A laboratory test in which a clinical specimen is placed in conditions that allow microorganisms to grow and be identified; susceptibility testing may

help guide treatment.

Culture And Sensitivity

A laboratory test that grows microorganisms from a sample and checks which medicines can stop them. It helps identify the cause of an infection and select effective treatment.

Culture Media

Nutrient materials prepared to grow microorganisms in a laboratory, with different formulas chosen for specific organisms, tests, or identification purposes.

Culture-Negative Endocarditis

Infective endocarditis in which routine blood cultures do not identify an organism, often because of prior antibiotics, fastidious bacteria, fungi, or noninfectious mimics; diagnosis requires integrated clinical, imaging, and laboratory assessment.

Culture Swab

A sterile swab used to collect material from skin, wounds, the throat, genital tract, or another site for laboratory culture. The test may identify bacteria or fungi and guide antibiotic choice; viral testing usually uses separate molecular or antigen tests.

Cumulative Dose

The total amount of a substance or radiation received over time. Cumulative exposure matters for medicines, toxins, radiation, carcinogens, and pregnancy-related risks because effects may build gradually.

Cumulative Trauma Disorder

Pain or injury that develops after repeated forceful, awkward, or prolonged movements. It may affect muscles, tendons, nerves, or other soft tissues in the hands, arms, neck, shoulders, or back.

Cupping

Enlargement or deepening of the central depression in the optic disc, assessed during glaucoma evaluation and interpreted with eye pressure and other findings.

Alternate Names:
Optic-Disc Cupping; Glaucomatous Cupping

Cupping Therapy

A complementary practice that places cups on the skin to create suction, sometimes after small skin cuts. It may leave bruises or marks and can cause burns, infection, or blood loss; evidence of benefit varies by condition.

Cup-To-Disc Ratio

A comparison between the central hollow of the optic nerve and the whole visible optic nerve head. An enlarged or changing ratio may suggest glaucoma; eye pressure and other findings affect its significance.

CURB-65 Score

A five-point tool estimating the severity of community-acquired pneumonia using confusion, blood urea, breathing rate, blood pressure, and age 65 or older. It helps guide hospital decisions but does not replace clinical judgment.

Curcumin

A yellow compound in turmeric that has anti-inflammatory effects in laboratory studies. Evidence that supplements treat disease is limited or variable, and concentrated products can interact with medicines or cause stomach or liver problems.

Cure

Complete elimination or permanent resolution of a disease. The meaning of cure varies by condition; remission or no detectable disease does not always mean that a disease has been cured.

Curettage

Removal or sampling of tissue by scraping with a curette, a spoon-shaped or ring-shaped instrument. It is used in procedures involving the uterus, skin lesions, bone lesions, and gum pockets.

Curettage Specimen

Tissue scraped or scooped from a body surface, cavity, or bone lesion for laboratory examination.

Because the pieces are often small and fragmented, they may not show the full structure or depth of disease.

Curette

A spoon-shaped or ring-shaped surgical instrument used to scrape, remove, or clean tissue from a cavity, bone, skin lesion, or tooth-supporting area. Its use and risks depend on the procedure and body site.

Curie

A unit of radioactivity equal to 3.7 billion nuclear disintegrations per second; the SI unit is the becquerel.

Curling's Ulcer

An acute peptic ulcer associated with severe burns, often occurring in the duodenum or stomach during physiologic stress.

Curling Ulcer

An acute ulcer in the stomach or duodenum that can develop after severe burns. Reduced blood flow and major physical stress weaken the digestive lining and may cause dangerous bleeding.

Currant Jelly Sputum

A distinctive thick, viscous, dark-red, blood-tinged mucoid sputum characteristic of acute destructive lobar pneumonia caused by Klebsiella pneumoniae, produced by extensive alveolar necrosis, hemorrhage, and abundant capsular polysaccharide secretion.

Alternate Names:
Klebsiella Sputum; Red Currant Jelly Sputum

Curschmann Spirals

Microscopic corkscrew-shaped casts of condensed mucus and desquamated bronchial epithelial cells found in sputum or bronchoalveolar lavage fluid, representing plugs formed in small distal bronchioles in patients with bronchial asthma and chronic bronchitis.

Alternate Names:
Curschmann's Spirals; Bronchial Mucus Casts

Curvature Of The Penis

A bend of the erect or flaccid penis caused by congenital tissue asymmetry, scar tissue such as Peyronie disease, trauma, or other conditions; it may impair intercourse or cause pain.

Alternate Names:
Penile Curvature

Curvature of the Spine (Scoliosis)

Abnormal sideways curvature and rotation of the spine. It may be idiopathic, congenital, neuromuscular, or degenerative and can cause asymmetry, pain, reduced function, or impaired breathing when severe.

Curvularia Alcornii

A dark-pigmented environmental fungus that rarely causes infection. It may affect the skin, sinuses, or brain, mainly in people with weakened immunity, and requires specialist laboratory identification and treatment.

Cushing Disease

Cushing syndrome caused by an adrenocorticotropic hormone-secreting pituitary tumor. Excess cortisol can cause central weight gain, rounded facial features, skin changes, muscle weakness, high blood pressure, high blood glucose, and menstrual or mood changes.

Cushingoid

Resembling the physical features of excess glucocorticoid exposure, such as a round face, central weight gain, thin skin, easy bruising, and muscle weakness.

Cushing's Disease

A pituitary tumor that makes too much adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH), causing the adrenal glands to produce too much cortisol. Features may include weight gain around the trunk, a round face, easy bruising, purple stretch marks, muscle weakness, high blood pressure, high blood glucose, and menstrual or mood changes.

Cushing Syndrome

A hormonal disorder caused by prolonged, abnormally high levels of cortisol (the body's primary stress hormone) in the bloodstream. It most commonly results from long-term use of oral steroid medications, or less commonly from a tumor in the pituitary or adrenal glands that produces excess hormones. Classic signs include a round 'moon' face, a fatty hump between the shoulders, easy bruising, purple stretch marks on the abdomen, high blood pressure, and muscle weakness.

Alternate Names:
Cortisol Excess Syndrome; Cushing's Syndrome; Cushing's Syndrome

Cushing Syndrome Complications

Long-term excess cortisol can cause high blood pressure, diabetes, infections, blood clots, weak bones, muscle weakness, and heart or blood-vessel disease. Treating the cause and monitoring these problems can reduce complications.

Cushing Syndrome Due To Adrenal Tumor

Excess cortisol caused by an adrenal tumor, producing Cushing syndrome with features such as central weight gain, hypertension, diabetes, muscle weakness, and skin changes.

Cushing Triad

A classic constellation of physiological responses indicating life-threateningly elevated intracranial pressure and impending transtentorial or tonsillar brainstem herniation, consisting of systolic hypertension with widened pulse pressure, bradycardia, and irregular respirations.

Alternate Names:
Cushing's Triad; Cushing Reflex

Cushing Ulcer

An acute stomach or duodenal ulcer associated with severe brain disease, head injury, or neurosurgery. Excess nerve stimulation can increase acid production and cause abdominal pain or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Cusp

A pointed projection, such as a projection of a tooth or one of the leaflets of a heart valve.

Cusp Fracture

A break in one of the raised points of a tooth, often around a large filling or weakened tooth. It may cause pain when biting or sensitivity and may require a bonded repair, crown, or other dental treatment.

Cut

A break or incision made in tissue, usually by a sharp object; the depth, contamination, and location determine the required care.

Cutaneous

Relating to the skin. The skin forms a protective barrier, helps control temperature, senses touch and pain, and supports vitamin D production. Skin findings can provide clues to infections, immune diseases, hormone disorders, and skin cancers.

Cutaneous Abscess

A collection of pus in the skin or tissues beneath it, usually caused by bacterial infection. It may be painful, red, warm, and swollen; treatment commonly involves drainage and sometimes antibiotics.

Cutaneous and Oral Melanocytic Nevi

Usually benign moles composed of melanocytes in the skin or oral mucosa. Most remain stable; changes in size, colour, border, surface, or symptoms can occur with atypia or melanoma.

Cutaneous Angiosarcoma

A fast-growing cancer of blood-vessel cells in the skin, usually on the scalp or face of older adults. It may look like a bruise, ulcerate, and spread.

Cutaneous Anthrax

A skin infection caused by Bacillus anthracis, usually producing a painless black sore surrounded by swelling.

Cutaneous B-Cell Lymphoma

A group of non-Hodgkin lymphomas in which clonal B lymphocytes primarily involve the skin. Primary cutaneous follicle-centre and marginal-zone lymphomas often behave indolently, whereas diffuse large B-cell lymphoma, leg type, is more aggressive; biopsy, staging, and immunophenotyping guide treatment.

Cutaneous Bleeding

Leakage of blood into the skin or the tissue just beneath it. It may appear as tiny red or purple spots called petechiae, larger areas called purpura, or bruises called ecchymoses. Causes include injury, low platelet levels, clotting disorders, fragile blood vessels, and medicines such as anticoagulants.

Cutaneous Candidiasis

A Candida yeast infection of the skin, often affecting warm, moist folds such as the groin, armpits, or under the breasts. It causes red, itchy, moist plaques with small satellite spots; diabetes, antibiotics, occlusion, and immune suppression increase risk.

Cutaneous Diphtheria

A skin infection caused by Corynebacterium diphtheriae bacteria. It usually produces a long-lasting ulcer or sore that may have a gray membrane and can spread toxin or infection to other people.

Cutaneous Drug Reaction

A skin reaction caused by a medicine taken by mouth, given by injection, or applied to the skin. It may be allergic or nonallergic and can cause a rash, itching, hives, blisters, peeling, or pain; widespread blistering, mouth sores, fever, facial swelling, or breathing difficulty may indicate a severe reaction.

Cutaneous Horn

A cone-shaped, hard projection of compacted keratin arising from the skin. The underlying lesion may be benign, precancerous, or cancerous, especially when the base is broad, indurated, painful, or inflamed, so removal or biopsy is usually needed.

Cutaneous Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

An uncommon disorder in which abnormal immune cells build up in the skin. It may cause scaly or crusted spots, rash, or purple marks; testing checks whether other organs are involved.

Cutaneous Larva Migrans

An intensely itchy, winding skin rash caused by hookworm larvae from contaminated soil or sand entering bare skin. The larvae move beneath the skin and usually die without reaching internal organs.

Cutaneous Leiomyoma

A usually benign smooth-muscle tumour of the skin, often presenting as firm, painful papules or nodules that may be triggered by cold or pressure. Multiple lesions can be associated with hereditary leiomyomatosis and renal-cell cancer, so extensive or familial disease needs genetic and renal-risk assessment.

Cutaneous Leishmaniasis

Infection of the skin by *Leishmania* parasites, usually transmitted by the bite of an infected female sand fly. One or more lesions often begin as bumps or nodules and may develop into long-lasting ulcers, usually on exposed skin; they are often painless and can heal with scars. Some parasite species can later affect the mucous membranes of the nose, mouth, or throat.

Cutaneous Lipomas

Multiple benign tumors of mature fat cells arising in or beneath the skin, usually soft, mobile, and painless. A rapidly growing, painful, fixed, or deep mass needs imaging or biopsy because not every fatty-appearing lump is a simple lipoma.

Cutaneous Lupus

A form of lupus erythematosus limited to the skin, manifesting as discoid lesions, subacute cutaneous plaques, or acute malar erythema. It may occur in isolation or as a feature of systemic lupus erythematosus.

Cutaneous Lupus Erythematosus

An immune disorder causing inflamed skin patches

or sores that may worsen with sunlight, scar, or change skin color. It may remain limited to skin or occur with systemic lupus and requires appropriate evaluation.

Cutaneous Lymphoma

A cancer of immune cells that mainly affects the skin. It may cause persistent patches, plaques, lumps, or widespread redness. The exact type determines whether it behaves slowly or aggressively and how it is treated.

Cutaneous Manifestations of HIV

Skin findings associated with HIV infection may reflect acute HIV, opportunistic infections, inflammatory disease, medicine reactions, or cancers such as Kaposi sarcoma. Conditions including herpes zoster, molluscum contagiosum, candidiasis, and extensive or recurrent eruptions may become more severe as immune function declines; effective antiretroviral therapy often improves HIV-related skin disease.

Cutaneous Melanoma

A malignant tumor of melanocytes, the pigment-producing cells of skin. It may arise in a new lesion or a changing mole and can spread; ABCDE features include asymmetry, border irregularity, colour variation, diameter, and evolution, while bleeding or a nonhealing pigmented spot can also occur.

Cutaneous Metastases

Secondary deposits of cancer in the skin, originating from a primary tumor elsewhere in the body. They may present as nodules, plaques, or ulcers, and often indicate advanced or recurrent disease.

Cutaneous Metastasis

A deposit of malignant cells in the skin from a primary tumor elsewhere or, less often, another cutaneous site; it may present as a firm nodule, plaque, or inflammatory-appearing lesion.

Cutaneous Penile Lesions

Abnormal skin findings on the penis, including papules, plaques, blisters, ulcers, or growths. Causes range from normal variants and irritation to infection, inflammatory skin disease, and precancerous or cancerous lesions. Assessment depends on appearance and history; persistent, changing, bleeding, or ulcerated lesions need clinical evaluation, and some require biopsy.

Alternate Names:
Penile Lesions; Penile Skin Lesions

Cutaneous Polyarteritis Nodosa

Inflammation of small and medium blood vessels limited mainly to the skin. It may cause painful lumps, a net-like purple pattern, or ulcers, usually on the legs, without the internal-organ disease seen in systemic forms.

Cutaneous Pseudolymphoma

A benign reactive lymphoid proliferation in the skin that can resemble cutaneous lymphoma clinically or under the microscope. It may follow an insect bite, tattoo, medicine, infection, or other stimulus; biopsy and sometimes additional studies are needed to distinguish it from true lymphoma.

Cutaneous Sarcoidosis

Sarcoidosis affecting the skin. It may cause firm bumps, plaques, or nodules, or thickening around old scars; some lesions are red-brown, purple, or skin-colored. Skin disease may occur alone or with sarcoidosis in other organs. Erythema nodosum can occur with sarcoidosis but is a separate, nonspecific skin reaction.

Cutaneous Skin Tag

A small, soft, usually harmless growth of extra skin, often on a narrow stalk in the neck, armpit, groin, or another skin fold. It may catch on clothing or become irritated.

Cutaneous Small-Vessel Vasculitis

Inflammation of tiny blood vessels in the skin, often causing groups of raised purple spots, especially on the lower legs. Medicines, infections, and immune diseases can trigger it; tests may check whether other organs are involved.

Cutaneous Squamous Cell Carcinoma

An invasive malignant tumor arising from keratinocytes in the epidermis, often on chronically sun-damaged skin. It may appear as a firm, rough, scaly, crusted, tender, or ulcerated growth. It can invade nearby tissue and sometimes metastasize, especially when high-risk features are present.

Alternate Names:
Squamous Cell Carcinoma Of The Skin; Squamous Cell Skin Cancer; cSCC

Cutaneous T-Cell Lymphoma

A cancer of immune cells that mainly affects the skin. It may begin as itchy, scaly patches or thicker plaques and later form lumps or widespread redness; some types also involve the blood, lymph nodes, or other organs.

Cutaneous Vasculitis

Inflammation of small blood vessels in the skin, causing red or purple spots, raised purpura, blisters, sores, or pain. Medicines, infections, autoimmune disease, or inflammation elsewhere in the body may be responsible.

Cuticle

The thin outermost layer of a hair shaft formed by overlapping cells that protect the inner cortex.

Alternate Names:
Hair Cuticle; Cuticular Layer

Cuticle Remover Poisoning

Exposure to cuticle-remover products, which may contain alkaline or acidic chemicals that can injure the skin, eyes, mouth, or gastrointestinal tract.

Cutis Anserina

Gooseflesh or piloerection, in which contraction of tiny muscles around hair follicles makes the skin appear rough or dimpled.

Cutis Laxa

A group of inherited or acquired connective-tissue disorders characterized by loose, inelastic skin caused by abnormal elastic fibers. Some forms also affect the lungs, blood vessels, heart, gastrointestinal tract, or skeleton.

Cutis Marmorata

A usually temporary, net-like mottling of the skin, often seen in infants or after cold exposure. It reflects a vascular response to temperature and generally fades with warming. Persistent congenital reticulated lesions may represent a distinct vascular malformation.

Alternate Names:
Mottled Skin; Physiologic Cutis Marmorata

Cutis Verticis Gyrata

A rare condition in which thickened scalp skin forms deep folds and furrows resembling the surface of the brain. It may be primary or associated with neurologic, endocrine, inflammatory, or genetic conditions.

Cuts And Puncture Wounds

Breaks in the skin caused by sharp, blunt, or penetrating trauma; evaluation considers depth, contamination, retained foreign bodies, tendon or nerve injury, vascular damage, and tetanus protection.

Alternate Names:
Lacerations; Minor Open Traumatic Wounds

Cuts and Wounds

Alternate name; see *Wound Care*.

Cutting Balloon Catheter

A balloon catheter with tiny blades or scoring surfaces that make controlled cuts in hardened plaque while the balloon widens a narrowed blood vessel. It is used in selected vascular procedures.

Alternate Names:
Cutting Balloon Angioplasty

CVC

Central venous catheter, a catheter whose tip lies in a large central vein and provides intravenous access for medications, fluids, nutrition, or monitoring.

Cyanide

A highly poisonous chemical that prevents cells from using oxygen. Exposure can rapidly cause headache, confusion, seizures, breathing failure, cardiovascular collapse, and death.

Cyanide Poisoning

A medical emergency in which cyanide stops cells from using oxygen. It may follow smoke inhalation or industrial, accidental, or intentional exposure and can cause headache, confusion, seizures, collapse, and death within minutes.

Cyanide Toxicity

Cellular asphyxiation caused by inhibition of mitochondrial oxidative phosphorylation. Rapid agitation or confusion, seizures, cardiovascular collapse, severe lactic acidosis, and coma may develop after smoke inhalation or ingestion; treatment must not await confirmatory testing when suspicion is high, and hydroxocobalamin is the preferred antidote in many settings.

Cyanoacrylates Poisoning

Exposure to cyanoacrylate adhesives, commonly known as instant glue. Contact may bond tissues or irritate the skin, eyes, or airways; ingestion usually causes local adhesion or irritation.

Cyanosis

A bluish or gray discoloration of the skin or mucous membranes associated with increased deoxygenated haemoglobin or abnormal haemoglobin. Central cyanosis affects the lips and tongue and usually reflects reduced arterial oxygenation; peripheral cyanosis mainly affects the extremities and may occur when blood flow is slow.

Cyanotic

Having a bluish or slate-gray discoloration of skin or mucous membranes, usually reflecting increased deoxygenated hemoglobin or abnormal blood flow.

Cyanotic Congenital Heart Disease

A group of congenital structural heart defects that cause low oxygen levels in systemic blood, usually through right-to-left shunting, mixing of oxygen-poor and oxygen-rich blood, or reduced blood flow to the lungs. Examples include tetralogy of Fallot, transposition of the great arteries, tricuspid atresia, and truncus arteriosus. Cyanosis may be subtle or absent initially.

Alternate Names:
Cyanotic Congenital Heart Defects

Cyanotic Heart Disease

A congenital or acquired heart disorder that reduces systemic oxygen saturation and causes cyanosis, often through right-to-left shunting or inadequate pulmonary blood flow.

CyberKnife Radiosurgery

CyberKnife is a robotic system that delivers many precisely aimed radiation beams to a tumor or other target without an open operation.

Cycle Time

The time needed to complete one cycle of a medical process, such as collecting an image or recording a repeating body signal. The length depends on the test, equipment, and purpose.

Cyclic Citrullinated Peptide

A substance used in a blood test for antibodies associated with rheumatoid arthritis. A positive result supports the diagnosis but is not diagnostic by itself.

Cyclic Edema

Recurrent swelling, often of the legs or hands, that changes with the menstrual cycle or other regular hormonal pattern. The diagnosis requires exclusion of heart, kidney, liver, venous, lymphatic, medication-related, and other causes of edema.

Cyclic Guanosine Monophosphate

A chemical messenger inside cells that helps relax smooth muscle, widen blood vessels, process visual signals, and control other body functions. Some medicines work partly by increasing or preserving its effects.

Alternate Names:
CGMP; Cyclic GMP

Cyclic Hormone Therapy

Hormone therapy in which estrogen is given continuously or for part of a cycle and progestogen is added for a defined number of days.

Alternate Names:
Sequential Hormone Therapy; Cyclic Estrogen-Progestogen Therapy

Cyclic Migraines

Migraine attacks that recur in a predictable pattern, sometimes around menstruation or at regular intervals. They may include headache, nausea, light or sound sensitivity, and aura; preventive treatment may be considered when attacks are frequent or disabling.

Cyclic Neutropenia

Repeated episodes of low neutrophils, the white blood cells that fight many infections. Episodes often recur at regular intervals and may cause fever, mouth ulcers, sore throat, or infections.

Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome

Repeated, similar attacks of severe nausea and vomiting separated by periods of normal health. It is often related to migraine biology; dehydration and other causes must be considered during evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Cyclic Vomiting

Cyclin-Dependent Kinase

An enzyme that helps control cell growth and division by working with a cyclin protein. Abnormal activity can contribute to cancer, and some targeted medicines block these enzymes.

Cyclist's Syndrome

Pain, numbness, tingling, or altered sensation in the perineum caused by prolonged pressure on the pudendal nerve during cycling. It is a form of pudendal nerve irritation or entrapment and may improve with changes in saddle fit, riding position, activity, and specialist treatment.

Alternate Names:
Cyclist Syndrome; Pudendal Neuralgia Associated With Cycling

Cyclocryotherapy

A cyclodestructive glaucoma procedure that freezes part of the ciliary body to reduce aqueous-humor production and intraocular pressure. It has been used mainly in severe or treatment-resistant glaucoma.

Cyclooxygenase

An enzyme family that helps convert arachidonic acid into prostaglandins and related mediators involved in pain, inflammation, and platelet function.

Alternate Names:
COX Enzyme; Prostaglandin-Endoperoxide Synthase

Cyclooxygenase-2

An inducible cyclooxygenase enzyme that generates prostaglandins involved in inflammation, pain, and fever and is inhibited by COX-2-selective medicines.

Cyclops

An informal term with two medical uses: cyclopia, a severe congenital malformation with a single central eye, and a cyclops lesion, a fibrous nodule in the knee joint, usually after anterior cruciate ligament injury or reconstruction, that can block full knee extension.

Cyclospora Infection

An intestinal infection caused by Cyclospora parasites, usually acquired from contaminated food or water. It can cause prolonged or recurring watery diarrhea, cramps, nausea, tiredness, and weight loss.

Cyclosporiasis

An intestinal infection caused by the parasite Cyclospora cayetanensis. It is usually spread through contaminated food or water and may cause prolonged or repeated watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, tiredness, loss of appetite, and

weight loss.

Alternate Names:
Cyclospora Cayetanensis Enteritis; Cyclospora Infection

Cyclothymia

Alternate name for *Cyclothymic Disorder*; see that entry.

Cyclothymic Disorder

A chronic mood disorder marked by numerous periods of hypomanic symptoms and depressive symptoms that do not meet full criteria for manic, hypomanic, or major depressive episodes. In adults, symptoms persist for at least two years; in children and adolescents, at least one year. They occur for at least half that time, with no symptom-free interval longer than two months.

Cylindroma

A usually benign adnexal tumor composed of basaloid cells, often presenting as a firm pink or skin-coloured nodule on the scalp or face; multiple lesions may occur in Brooke-Spiegler syndrome.

Cylindroma and Spiradenoma

Usually benign skin appendage tumors arising from sweat-gland-related structures. Cylindromas are often firm scalp or facial nodules, while spiradenomas are characteristically painful; multiple lesions may occur in Brooke-Spiegler syndrome and a rapidly enlarging or ulcerated lesion needs review.

CYP2C19 Polymorphism

An inherited difference in a liver enzyme that breaks down some medicines. It can make a medicine act too weakly or too strongly, so genetic or medicine review may guide treatment for selected drugs.

CYP2C9 Polymorphism

An inherited variation in the CYP2C9 drug-metabolizing enzyme that can make some medicines, especially warfarin, break down more slowly or quickly. Genotype may help inform dosing in selected settings, alongside clinical factors and monitoring.

CYP2D6 Polymorphism

An inherited difference in a liver enzyme that breaks down many medicines. Some people process certain drugs slowly or quickly, which can change their benefits and side effects.

CYP450 System

A family of enzymes, found mainly in the liver, that breaks down many medicines and foreign chemicals. Genetic differences and other medicines can speed up or slow down this process and alter drug effects.

Cyproheptadine Overdose

Overdose of cyproheptadine, an antihistamine, that may cause sedation, agitation, anticholinergic effects, seizures, respiratory depression, or cardiac effects.

Cyprus Fever

An older regional name for brucellosis, a bacterial infection acquired from infected animals or unpasteurised animal products. It may cause prolonged or recurring fever, sweats, fatigue, joint pain, and involvement of other organs.

Alternate Names:
Brucellosis; Malta Fever; Mediterranean Fever

Cyst

A closed sac containing fluid, air, cells, or semisolid material. Cysts can occur in the skin, organs, glands, or other tissues and may be harmless, infected, or related to another disease.

Cystadenoma

A usually noncancerous gland-forming tumor containing fluid-filled spaces or cyst-like structures. It can occur in several organs, may enlarge or cause symptoms, and sometimes requires removal or monitoring.

Cystectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the urinary bladder. Partial cystectomy is used for selected localized disease; complete or radical cystectomy removes the bladder and requires another route for urine to leave

the body.

Cystic Acne

Severe acne with deep, painful lumps that can leave permanent scars. It often needs clinician-directed treatment; squeezing or picking the lesions increases scarring and infection risk.

Cystic Diseases of the Kidney

Disorders in which fluid-filled cysts develop in one or both kidneys. They may be inherited or acquired and can cause enlargement, pain, infection, bleeding, stones, high blood pressure, or progressive loss of kidney function.

Cystic Echinococcosis

A parasitic infection in which slowly growing cysts form, most often in the liver or lungs, after swallowing Echinococcus eggs from infected dogs or contaminated food, water, or soil. Cysts may cause pain, cough, blockage, or serious allergic reactions if they rupture.

Cysticercosis

Infection caused by the larval form of the pork tapeworm, *Taenia solium*, after a person swallows its eggs from contaminated food, water, or hands. Cysts may form in muscle, skin, the eyes, or the brain. Brain infection, called neurocysticercosis, may cause seizures, headaches, or other nervous-system problems. Cysticercosis is different from intestinal taeniasis and is not caused by eating undercooked pork.

Cystic Fibrosis

An inherited genetic disorder caused by a faulty gene that controls the movement of salt and water into and out of cells. This defect causes the body to produce unusually thick, sticky mucus that clogs the airways in the lungs, leading to chronic infections and progressive breathing problems. The thick mucus also blocks the ducts in the pancreas, preventing digestive enzymes from reaching the intestines and causing digestive problems and poor growth.

Cystic Fibrosis Carrier Screening

Genetic testing to identify a person who carries one disease-causing CFTR variant and usually has no cystic-fibrosis symptoms. Results help estimate reproductive risk and guide partner testing or genetic counseling.

Cystic Hygroma

A fluid-filled growth made of enlarged lymph vessels, usually in the neck or upper chest. It is present from birth or develops in early childhood. A large one can cause swelling or make breathing or feeding difficult.

Alternate Names:
Cystic Lymphangioma

Cystic Kidney Disease

A group of disorders in which fluid-filled cysts develop in one or both kidneys. Some forms are inherited, while others develop later; cysts may enlarge the kidneys or reduce their function.

Cystic Lung Disease

A group of disorders in which multiple air- or fluid-filled cysts develop in the lungs. Causes include lymphangioleiomyomatosis, pulmonary Langerhans-cell histiocytosis, Birt-Hogg-Dubé syndrome, lymphoid interstitial pneumonia, congenital abnormalities, infection, and smoking-related disease; high-resolution CT helps classify the pattern.

Alternate Names:
Multiple Cystic Lung Disease; Pulmonary Cystic Disease

Cystic Medial Necrosis

An older term for weakening of the middle layer of the aortic wall. The weakened aorta may stretch into an aneurysm or tear, especially in people with inherited connective-tissue disorders, high blood pressure, or aging-related disease.

Cystic Teratoma

A germ-cell tumor containing tissues derived from more than one embryonic layer, commonly occurring in the ovary as a mature cystic teratoma or dermoid cyst. Most are benign, but torsion, rup-

ture, infection, or rare malignant transformation can occur.

Cystine and Struvite Urinary Crystals

Two types of crystals that may appear in urine. Cystine crystals can indicate an inherited tendency to form stones, while struvite crystals may occur with some urinary infections; results need clinical interpretation.

Alternate Names:
Hexagonal Cystine and Magnesium Ammonium Phosphate Crystals; Urinary Calculi Crystals

Cystine Stones

Kidney stones formed when inherited cystinuria causes excess cystine in urine. They often recur and may be difficult to dissolve; abundant fluids, medical treatment, and sometimes procedures help prevent or remove them.

Cystinosis

A rare inherited disorder in which cystine, a building block of proteins, builds up inside cells and damages organs. It often affects the kidneys and eyes and may also impair growth, the thyroid, muscles, or other tissues.

Cystinuria

An inherited disorder in which the kidneys release too much cystine into urine, allowing recurrent cystine kidney stones to form. It requires long-term fluid intake, monitoring, and sometimes medicines to prevent stones.

Cystitis

Inflammation of the bladder that may be caused by infection, irritation, medicines, radiation, or other conditions. It can cause burning or discomfort with urination, frequent or urgent urination, lower-abdominal pressure, or blood in the urine; some forms cause bladder or pelvic pain without infection.

Cystitis Pathology

Inflammatory injury of the urinary bladder mucosa and wall. Acute cases may show edema, congestion, and neutrophils, while chronic or specialized forms show lymphocytes, fibrosis, ulceration, or characteristic epithelial changes.

Cystocele

Bulging of the bladder into the front wall of the vagina because the supporting pelvic tissues have weakened. It may cause pelvic pressure, a vaginal bulge, urinary leakage, difficulty emptying the bladder, or no symptoms.

Cystography

X-ray or other imaging of the urinary bladder after contrast is placed in it. It can show bladder injury, leaks, fistulas, structural abnormalities, or urine flowing backward toward the kidneys.

Cystoid Macular Edema

Swelling at the center of the retina caused by fluid collecting in small cyst-like spaces. It can blur or distort central vision and may follow eye surgery, inflammation, diabetes, or retinal blood-vessel disease.

Cystoisosporiasis

An intestinal infection caused by the parasite Cystoisospora belli. It is usually spread by swallowing contaminated food or water and may cause watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, vomiting, loss of appetite, and fever. The illness may be prolonged or severe in people with weakened immune systems.

Cystometric Study

A bladder test that measures pressure, sensation, and urine storage while the bladder fills and empties. It helps investigate urgency, leakage, difficulty emptying, weak bladder muscles, or nerve-related urinary problems.

Cystometrogram

A recording of bladder pressure and sensation during filling and emptying. It is part of urodynamic testing used to investigate leakage, urgency, blockage, weak contractions, or nerve-related bladder problems.

Cystometry

A bladder-function test measuring pressure and sensation while the bladder fills and empties. It helps assess urgency, leakage, obstruction, weak contractions, nerve problems, or other urinary difficulties.

Cystoscope

A thin, lighted instrument used to examine the urethra and bladder and, when needed, perform procedures.

Cystoscopy

Cystoscopy uses a camera passed through the urethra to inspect the bladder and urethra and may allow biopsy or treatment.

Cystostomy

A procedure that creates an opening from the bladder to the skin or another passage so urine can drain when it cannot leave normally through the urethra. It may be temporary or long term.

Cystotome

A small surgical instrument used to cut the thin covering of the eye's lens during selected cataract procedures. Modern instruments and techniques vary according to the operation.

Cystourethrography

An X-ray examination of the bladder and urethra after contrast material is placed in the bladder. Images during filling and urination can show leaks, narrowing, structural problems, or urine flowing backward toward the kidneys.

Cysts

Closed sacs or tissue cavities containing fluid, air, pus, blood, cells, or semisolid material. They can occur in the skin, organs, glands, or other tissues; many are harmless, but some result from infection, developmental or inherited disease, or a tumor. Cysts may be new, growing, painful, changing, or infected.

Cytochrome B5 Reductase

An enzyme that keeps hemoglobin in the chemical form needed to carry oxygen. An inherited deficiency can cause methemoglobinemia, in which the skin looks blue and blood cannot deliver oxygen normally.

Cytochrome C

A protein inside mitochondria that carries electrons during energy production. When released from damaged mitochondria, it can also help start the controlled death of a cell.

Cytochrome P450

A family of enzymes, found mainly in liver cells, that chemically changes many medicines, toxins, and hormones so the body can remove them. Genetic differences and drug interactions can alter their activity.

Cytogenetic Karyotyping

Alternate name; see *Karyotyping*.

Cytogenetics

The study of chromosomes, including their number, structure, and arrangement. Laboratory tests can help identify inherited conditions, developmental differences, some pregnancy problems, leukemia, and other cancers.

Cytokine

A diverse group of small signaling proteins produced by immune cells and other tissues that act as chemical messengers. They help coordinate the body's immune defenses, inflammation, and cellular communication by instructing other cells to grow, move toward an infection, or fight off pathogens.

Alternate Names:
Immune Signaling Proteins; Cytokine Mediators; Cytokines

Cytokine Release Syndrome

A potentially serious whole-body inflammatory reaction caused by a sudden release of immune signaling proteins, sometimes after immune-based cancer

treatment or infection. Fever, low blood pressure, breathing difficulty, and organ problems may occur.

Cytokines

Plural form; see *Cytokine*.

Cytokine Signaling

Communication between cells through cytokines binding to specific receptors and activating intracellular pathways. It regulates immune responses, inflammation, blood-cell production, tissue repair, and interactions between organs.

Cytokine Storm

A dangerous overreaction of the immune system in which large amounts of inflammatory messenger proteins are released. It can cause widespread tissue injury, low blood pressure, breathing failure, organ damage, and shock.

Cytologic Evaluation

Microscopic examination of individual cells or small cell groups from a fluid, brushing, scraping, or fine-needle sample to detect infection, inflammation, or malignancy.

Cytology

The study of individual cells under a microscope. Cells may come from a body fluid, scraping, brushing, or needle sample and can be examined for cancer, infection, inflammation, or other disease.

Cytology Exam Of Pleural Fluid

Microscopic examination of fluid around the lung for malignant cells and other cellular changes, performed with chemical and microbiologic testing when evaluating an effusion.

Cytology Exam Of Urine

Microscopic examination of shed urinary-tract cells, used mainly to detect high-grade urothelial malignancy and selected abnormal cells; a negative result does not exclude cancer.

Cytomegalovirus

A common herpesvirus that often causes no symptoms or a mild illness in healthy people. It can cause serious disease in unborn babies and people with weakened immunity, affecting organs such as the lungs, eyes, brain, or digestive tract.

Alternate Names:
CMV; Human Betaherpesvirus 5; Human Cytomegalovirus (HCMV)

Cytomegalovirus Colitis

Alternate name; see *CMV Colitis* and *Cytomegalovirus Gastroenteritis and Colitis*.

Cytomegalovirus Gastroenteritis and Colitis

An opportunistic viral gastrointestinal infection caused by cytomegalovirus (CMV) reactivation in severely immunocompromised individuals (e.g., advanced HIV/AIDS, solid-organ transplantation), characterized by mucosal ulceration, hematochezia, abdominal pain, and potential bowel perforation.

Alternate Names:
CMV Colitis; CMV Enteritis; Gastrointestinal Cytomegalovirus

Cytomegalovirus Infection

Infection with cytomegalovirus, which may cause no symptoms or a fever-and-fatigue illness in healthy people. Infection during pregnancy or in someone with weakened immunity can cause hearing loss, organ disease, or other serious complications.

Cytomegalovirus Retinitis

An infection of the retina caused by cytomegalovirus, usually in people with severe immune suppression, such as advanced HIV or after an organ transplant. It can cause floaters, blind spots, or blurred vision; examination may show yellow-white areas of retinal damage, sometimes with bleeding. Without treatment, it can cause permanent vision loss or retinal detachment.

Alternate Names:
CMV Retinitis; Cytomegaloviral Chorioretinitis

Cytopathology

The examination of individual cells under a microscope to help diagnose cancer, infection, inflammation, or other disease. Cells may come from fluid, a brushing, a smear, or a needle sample.

Cytopenia

A lower-than-normal number of one or more blood-cell types: red blood cells, white blood cells, or platelets. The effects depend on which cells are low and how severe the reduction is.

Cytoplasm

The jelly-like material inside a cell outside its nucleus. It contains the cell's working structures and is where many chemical reactions, transport processes, and energy-producing activities occur.

Cytoreductive Surgery

Surgery that removes as much visible cancer as can be taken safely. It may not remove every cancer cell and is often combined with chemotherapy, radiation, or other treatment; its value depends on the cancer's type, site, and spread.

Cytoskeleton

A network of protein fibers inside a cell that maintains its shape, moves materials, enables movement, and helps the cell divide. It constantly changes in response to the cell's needs.

Cytotoxic

Toxic to cells or capable of killing cells, as with some chemotherapy drugs, toxins, or cytotoxic immune cells.

Cytotoxic Alopecia

Hair loss caused by exposure to a cytotoxic treatment or other toxic injury to actively growing hair follicles.

Alternate Names:
Drug-Induced Alopecia; Chemotherapy-Related Hair Loss

Cytotoxicity

The ability of a substance or cell to damage or kill another cell. This may be part of normal immune defense or may result from medicines, toxins, radiation, or other harmful exposures.

Cytotoxic T Cell

An immune cell that recognizes and kills infected, abnormal, or cancerous cells. It identifies small protein signals displayed on the target cell and can trigger that cell to die.

D

D2 Receptor

A protein on cells that responds to dopamine, a brain chemical involved in movement, motivation, and reward. Some medicines work partly by blocking or stimulating this receptor.

Dacarbazine

A chemotherapy medicine used for Hodgkin lymphoma, melanoma, and some other cancers. It may cause severe nausea, low blood counts, or liver injury.

Daclizumab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks the interleukin-2 receptor on activated T cells. Daclizumab was used to prevent kidney-transplant rejection, and a modified form was used for relapsing multiple sclerosis; the latter was withdrawn in 2018 after serious, sometimes fatal immune reactions affecting the brain, liver, and other organs.

Dacomitinib

A targeted medicine that blocks several members of the epidermal-growth-factor receptor family and is used for selected EGFR-mutated lung cancers. Diarrhea, skin reactions, mouth sores, and lung or liver problems may occur.

Da Costa's Syndrome

Historical term for a syndrome of breathlessness, palpitations, chest discomfort, dizziness, and fatigue, once called effort syndrome or neurocirculatory asthenia. It is now a nonspecific label rather than a precise modern diagnosis.

Dacrocytes

Teardrop-shaped red blood cells seen on a blood smear. They may occur when red blood cells pass through scarred or crowded bone marrow, and can be seen in myelofibrosis, bone-marrow cancers, and severe thalassemia.

Alternate Names:
Teardrop Cells

Dacryoadenitis

Inflammation of a tear-producing gland, causing painful swelling near the outer upper eyelid. It may be caused by infection, inflammation, or a condition affecting the whole body.

Dacryocystitis

Infection or inflammation of the tear sac near the inner corner of the eye, usually because the tear-drainage passage is blocked. It can cause pain, redness, swelling, and pus.

Dacryocystocele

A fluid-filled swelling near the inner corner of the eye caused by blockage and widening of the tear-drainage system. In a newborn it may interfere with breathing if it extends into the nose.

Dacryocystography

An imaging test in which contrast material is put into the tear-drainage passages to show narrowing, blockage, abnormal connections, or leakage. It may help plan treatment for persistent tearing or repeated tear-sac infection.

Dacryocystorhinostomy

Surgery creating a new passage from the tear sac into the nose to bypass a blocked tear duct. It is used for persistent tearing or repeated tear-sac infections.

Dacryocyte Analysis

Examination or counting of teardrop-shaped red blood cells on a blood smear; numerous dacryocytes may occur with marrow fibrosis, infiltration, severe anemia, or splenic disease.

Dacryolithiasis

Formation of a stone or concretion within the lacrimal drainage system, which may cause excessive tearing, discharge, recurrent dacryocystitis, or obstruction.

Dacryostenosis

Narrowing or blockage of the passages that drain tears from the eye into the nose. It can cause constant tearing, sticky discharge, or repeated infection of the tear sac.

Dactinomycin

An anticancer medicine that binds DNA and interferes with gene activity and cell growth. It is used for selected cancers and can cause bone-marrow suppression, mouth sores, nausea, and tissue injury if it leaks outside a vein.

Dactylitis

Swelling and inflammation of an entire finger or toe, producing a sausage-like appearance. It can occur with sickle-cell disease, psoriatic arthritis, infection, or other inflammatory conditions.

Dactylomegaly

Abnormal enlargement of a finger or toe, which may occur as an isolated finding or as part of an endocrine, skeletal, vascular, or inflammatory disorder.

Dactylosymphysis

Another name for syndactyly, the congenital joining of adjacent fingers or toes by skin, bone, or both; see *Syndactyly*.

Daidzein

A naturally occurring isoflavone found in soy and other legumes that can be converted by intestinal bacteria into related compounds.

Daily Bowel Care Program

A planned routine for preventing and treating constipation or fecal incontinence, often including timing, fluids, diet, activity, medication, and rectal measures when prescribed.

Dakin Solution

A dilute sodium hypochlorite solution used as a topical antiseptic for selected contaminated or infected wounds. Higher concentrations or prolonged exposure can damage viable tissue as well as microorganisms.

Dalrymple Sign

A clinical ophthalmologic sign characterized by abnormal widening of the palpebral fissure and retraction of the upper eyelid, revealing a strip of white sclera above the superior corneal limbus in primary gaze, classically seen in Graves ophthalmopathy and thyrotoxicosis.

Alternate Names:
Dalrymple's Sign; Thyrotoxic Eyelid Retraction

Dalteparin

An injectable blood thinner used to prevent or treat clots in veins and the lungs. It reduces clotting through the body's natural anticoagulant system; bleeding is the main risk, and kidney disease may require dose adjustment.

Dalteparin Sodium

Salt name; see *Dalteparin*.

Daltonism

Color-vision deficiency, especially difficulty distinguishing certain colors because of abnormal or absent retinal cone function.

DALY

Disability-adjusted life year, a measure combining years of healthy life lost because of premature death and disability.

DAMA

Abbreviation for discharge against medical advice: a patient's decision to leave the hospital before the care team recommends discharge.

Damage-Control Resuscitation

Emergency treatment for severe injury that quickly controls bleeding, gives appropriate blood products, prevents dangerous cooling, and corrects clotting problems while avoiding harmful excess fluid.

Damage-Control Surgery

A planned series of operations for a critically ill or severely injured person who cannot safely tolerate a long repair. The first operation controls bleeding or contamination; after stabilization, a later operation completes the repair.

Damage To The Amygdala

Damage to the amygdala can affect fear processing, emotional learning, memory, threat recognition, and social behavior. Causes include trauma, stroke, infection, tumor, epilepsy, or degenerative disease, and effects depend on the side and extent of injury.

Damus-Kaye-Stansel Procedure

A heart operation for selected children with a single working ventricle and a blocked or narrowed route from the ventricle to the aorta. It connects the pulmonary artery to the aorta to create a wider route for blood leaving the heart.

Alternate Names:
DKS Procedure; Damus-Stansel-Kaye Operation

Danazol

A synthetic androgen that suppresses pituitary gonadotropins. It is used to treat endometriosis and to prevent attacks of hereditary angioedema. Adverse effects include androgenic changes, abnormal blood lipids, liver injury, and blood clots.

Dance Sign

A clinical physical examination finding in pediatric intussusception characterized by a palpable emptiness or flattening in the right lower quadrant (ileocecal fossa), resulting from the invagination and distal displacement of the cecum and terminal ileum into the ascending colon.

Alternate Names:
Dance's Sign; Signe de Dance

D And C

Alternate name; see *D & C*.

D And E

Abbreviation; see *Dilation And Evacuation*.

Dander

Tiny flakes of skin shed by animals with fur or feathers. Dander can carry proteins that trigger allergy symptoms in some people. The flakes can float in the air and be breathed in, sometimes causing sneezing, itchy eyes, or asthma symptoms in people with an animal allergy.

Dandruff

A common scalp condition causing small white or yellow flakes and sometimes itching. It is often related to oily skin, seborrheic dermatitis, or the scalp's reaction to the normal yeast *Malassezia*; it is not usually contagious. Persistent severe flaking, redness, sores, or hair loss may indicate another scalp disorder.

Dandy Fever

Older name; see *Dengue*.

Dandy-Walker Malformation

A congenital malformation of the back of the brain, marked by an underdeveloped or partly absent cerebellar vermis, cyst-like enlargement of the fourth ventricle, and an enlarged posterior fossa. It may cause hydrocephalus, developmental delay, or problems with balance and coordination; symptoms vary.

Dandy-Walker Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Dandy-Walker Malformation*.

Dane Particle

The complete infectious form of hepatitis B virus. It contains the virus's genetic material inside a protein shell and outer envelope, allowing it to enter liver cells and reproduce.

Dangerous Abbreviations

Abbreviations that can be misread and cause medication or clinical errors; safer practice is to write the complete term when an abbreviation is ambiguous.

Danon Disease

A rare inherited disorder, usually caused by an LAMP2 gene change, in which cells cannot properly recycle materials. It may cause heart-muscle disease, muscle weakness, intellectual disability, or eye problems.

Dantrolene

A muscle relaxant that reduces the release of calcium inside muscle cells. It is the main treatment for malignant hyperthermia and may cause weakness or liver injury.

Dapsone

A sulfone antimicrobial used for leprosy, selected dermatitis, and other infections; haemolysis, especially with G6PD deficiency, methaemoglobinaemia, agranulocytosis, and severe skin reactions are important risks.

Daptomycin

An antibiotic used for selected serious infections caused by gram-positive bacteria, including resistant strains. It can damage muscles and kidneys, so treatment requires appropriate testing and monitoring.

Daptomycin Resistance

Reduced or absent response of bacteria to daptomycin, often because changes in the bacterial membrane prevent the antibiotic from working. It can develop during treatment and limits options for serious infections.

Darbepoetin Alfa

A long-acting medicine that stimulates the bone marrow to make more red blood cells. It is used for selected anemia related to kidney disease or cancer treatment, but can raise blood pressure and the risk of blood clots.

Darier's Disease

An inherited skin disorder that causes persistent, firm, often greasy or crusted bumps, usually on the chest, back, scalp, or skin folds. It may also change the nails or affect the mouth. Heat, sweating, friction, and sunlight can trigger flares.

Alternate Names:
Darier Disease; Darier-White Disease

Darier Sign

A raised, red, itchy swelling that appears within minutes when a skin lesion containing mast cells is rubbed. It supports a diagnosis of cutaneous mastocytosis, but its absence does not rule it out.

Alternate Names:
Darier's Sign; Mastocytoma Stroking Sign

Dark Adaptation

The gradual adjustment that allows the eyes to see better after moving from bright light into darkness. Poor dark adaptation may result from retinal disease, vitamin A deficiency, aging, or some medicines.

Dartos

A thin muscle layer beneath the skin of the scrotum. It tightens or relaxes the scrotal skin in response to temperature and other signals, helping regulate the position of the testicles.

Darunavir

An antiretroviral medicine that blocks HIV protease, an enzyme needed to make new viruses. It is used with other HIV medicines and has important interactions and possible liver or skin reactions.

Darwin's Tubercle

A harmless small bump on the upper rim of the outer ear. It is a common normal variation in ear shape and usually needs no treatment.

Dasatinib

A targeted cancer medicine that blocks abnormal tyrosine-kinase signals, especially those caused by BCR::ABL1. It treats selected blood cancers and may cause low blood counts, fluid around the lungs, bleeding, or abnormal heart rhythms.

DASH Diet

An eating pattern designed to lower blood pressure by emphasizing vegetables, fruits, whole grains, beans, nuts, and low-fat dairy while limiting salt, saturated fat, and sugary foods. Individual needs may require adjustment.

Dating Ultrasound

An ultrasound examination, usually performed in early pregnancy, used to estimate gestational age and calculate the expected date of delivery. First-trimester crown–rump length is generally the most accurate ultrasound measurement for dating.

Alternate Names:
Pregnancy Dating Scan; Gestational-Age Ultrasound

Daubenton's Plane

A craniometric reference plane passing through the opisthion, the midpoint of the posterior margin of the foramen magnum, and the lower margins of the orbits. It is used in describing skull orientation.

Daunorubicin

An anthracycline chemotherapy medicine that interferes with DNA and is used mainly for selected leukemias. It can suppress bone-marrow function and, especially after repeated exposure, damage the heart.

Alternate Names:
Daunorubicin Hydrochloride

Daunorubicin Hydrochloride

Alternate name for the hydrochloride salt of daunorubicin; see *Daunorubicin*.

David Procedure

An operation that replaces an enlarged or weakened aortic root while keeping the person's own aortic valve. The valve is supported inside a graft and the coronary arteries are reattached; bleeding, stroke, valve leakage, or recurrent aortic disease are possible.

Alternate Names:
David Operation; Valve-Sparing Root Replacement; Reimplantation of Aortic Valve

Dav Regimen

An abbreviation used for more than one cancer-treatment combination. In older leukemia reports, DAV meant daunorubicin, cytarabine, and etoposide; in newer reports, it may mean daunorubicin, cytarabine, and venetoclax. The source must identify the drugs and cancer before the regimen is used.

Daw

An abbreviation meaning dispense as written, indicating that the pharmacist should dispense the prescribed product rather than automatically substitute a generic equivalent when permitted by law.

Dawn Phenomenon

A rise in blood glucose during the early morning caused by normal hormone changes that help the body wake up. It may be more noticeable in people with diabetes whose insulin supply cannot match the rise.

Dawson Fingers

Long, finger-like areas seen on some brain MRI scans in multiple sclerosis. They form around small veins near the brain's fluid spaces and support, but do not by themselves prove, the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Dawson's Fingers; Perivenular MS Plaques

Day-Blindness

Poor vision in bright light, also called hemeralopia. It can result from retinal disease, cone dysfunction, or other eye disorders.

Day Hospital

A facility that provides multidisciplinary medical, psychiatric, rehabilitative, or diagnostic care during the day without overnight admission. It can support intensive treatment while allowing the patient to return home.

Daytime Sleepiness

A tendency to feel sleepy or fall asleep during waking hours. It may follow insufficient or disrupted sleep, or occur with sleep disorders, medicines, or other illnesses; persistent excessive sleepiness is a symptom rather than a diagnosis by itself.

DBA

Abbreviation for Diamond-Blackfan anemia, an inherited bone-marrow failure syndrome that usually causes anemia in infancy or early childhood and may be associated with characteristic physical differences or other congenital abnormalities.

D & C

Dilation and curettage, a procedure in which the cervix is widened and tissue is removed from the uterine cavity for treatment or diagnosis.

Dcc Gene

A gene that helps guide developing nerve fibers and may also help control cell growth. Harmful changes in this gene can cause some developmental nerve disorders and may contribute to certain cancers.

D&C Instruments

Instruments used to dilate the cervix and remove tissue from the uterus during dilation and curettage.

DCIS

Alternate name; see *Ductal Carcinoma In Situ*.

DDH

Alternate name; see *Hip Dysplasia*.

D-Dimer

A substance released into the blood when a blood clot breaks down. A high level can occur with a blood clot, but also with infection, pregnancy, recent surgery, cancer, or other conditions. A normal result can help rule out a clot in carefully selected patients whose initial risk is low or moderate.

D-Dimer Test

A blood test measuring a substance released when blood clots are broken down. A normal result can help rule out a clot in carefully selected low-risk people; a high result has many possible causes and does not prove a clot.

Alternate Names:
D-Dimer Assay; Fibrin Degradation Fragment Test

Deacetylase Inhibitor

A medicine or research compound that blocks enzymes removing chemical groups called acetyl groups from proteins. Some alter gene activity and are used for selected cancers; effects and risks depend on the specific medicine.

Dead Space

The part of a breath that does not exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide with the blood, including the nose, throat, and larger airways. It increases when air reaches lung areas with too little blood flow.

Dead Space Ventilation

Breathing that moves air through areas of the lungs where little or no blood is available for gas exchange. It may increase with a pulmonary embolism, low blood flow, or emphysema and can make breathing less effective.

Dead Time

The brief period after an event during which a detector or recording system cannot register another event, limiting the measured count rate.

Deafblindness

Combined hearing and vision loss that significantly affects communication, access to information, or moving around independently. The degree of hearing and sight loss varies; support is tailored to each person's remaining senses and communication needs.

Alternate Names:
Deaf-Blindness; Dual Sensory Loss

Deafferentation

Loss or interruption of nerve signals carrying sensation from a body area to the brain or spinal cord. It may cause numbness, unusual sensations, poor awareness of position, or persistent nerve pain.

Deafness

Complete or severe loss of hearing in one or both ears. The problem may involve sound passing through the outer or middle ear, the inner ear or hearing nerve, or more than one of these areas.

Death

The permanent end of life. It may be confirmed when the heart and breathing stop permanently or when all brain function has permanently stopped, according to medical and legal standards.

Death Rate

The number of deaths in a population during a stated period. It is often shown per 1,000 or 100,000 people and may be adjusted for age when comparing populations.

Death Rattle

Noisy, rattling breathing caused by secretions accumulating in the throat or upper airways, often occurring near the end of life when swallowing and coughing weaken.

Deauville Criteria

A five-point scale used on fluorodeoxyglucose PET scans to assess treatment response in lymphomas that take up the tracer. It compares uptake in suspected lymphoma with uptake in the blood pool in the middle of the chest and in the liver. Scores range from no abnormal uptake (1) to markedly greater uptake than the liver or new likely lymphoma sites (5); scores 2–4 fall between these levels.

Deaver Retractor

A hand-held surgical instrument with a broad, curved blade used to gently move organs or tissues aside. It is often used during chest or abdominal surgery to improve the surgeon's view.

Debility

General physical weakness or reduced ability to function, often caused by illness, aging, poor nutrition, prolonged inactivity, or recovery from major stress. Persistent weakness may have an underlying medical cause.

Alternate Names:
Weakness

Debride

To remove dead, damaged, infected, or contaminated tissue from a wound or body site to support healing and control infection.

Debridement

Removal of dead, damaged, infected, or contaminated tissue from a wound. It may be done with instruments, irrigation, or other methods to reduce infection, reveal healthy tissue, and support healing.

Debulk

To reduce the size or amount of a tumor or other abnormal tissue, usually by surgery or another treatment, without necessarily removing every abnormal cell.

Debulking

Removal of as much of a tumor as possible when removing all of it is unsafe or impossible. The aim is to reduce symptoms or improve the effect of later treatment; benefit depends on the cancer and situation.

Decalcification

Loss of calcium salts from bone, teeth, or other mineralized tissue. In teeth it may weaken enamel; in bone it can contribute to reduced strength.

Decannulation

Removal of a tube, especially a tracheostomy tube, after a person can breathe safely, protect the airway, and clear secretions without it. The site is monitored for bleeding, narrowing, or breathing difficulty.

Decanoic Acid

A ten-carbon saturated fatty acid, also called capric acid, found in some fats and studied for antimicrobial, metabolic, and antiseizure effects.

Decapitation

Separation of the head from the body, seen in severe trauma (vehicle accidents, train injuries, explosions), industrial accidents, hanging with judicial execution, or homicide. Complete decapitation is almost always rapidly fatal due to exsanguination and brain ischemia.

Decay Correction

A calculation that adjusts a radioactive measurement for the gradual loss of activity over time. It allows imaging or laboratory results obtained at different times to be compared accurately.

Deceased Donor

Individual who has died (usually from brain death or cardiac death) and donated organs, tissues, or both for transplantation.

Decenoic Acid

An unsaturated ten-carbon fatty acid; its biologic effects depend on the position and geometry of its double bond and on tissue and dietary context.

Decerebrate Posture

Abnormal straightening of the arms and legs caused by severe injury to the brainstem or nearby brain structures. It is a sign of serious neurologic injury and may occur after head injury, bleeding, or increased pressure in the skull.

Decerebrate Posturing

Alternate name; see *Decerebrate Posture*.

Decerebrate Rigidity

Alternate name; see *Decerebrate Posture*.

Decerebrate State

Alternate name; see *Decerebrate Posture*.

Decerebration

Severe brain dysfunction that causes abnormal straightening of the arms and legs. It usually results from major brain or brainstem injury or increased pressure inside the skull and is a medical emergency.

Decibel

A unit used to describe sound intensity. Higher values mean louder sound; repeated or very loud exposure can damage hearing, depending on the level and duration.

Decidua

The specialized lining of the uterus during pregnancy. It is shed after delivery and helps support the pregnancy and placenta.

Decidua Basalis

The pregnancy-modified endometrium beneath the implantation site, between the chorion and uterine muscle. It interfaces with chorionic villi and forms the maternal component of the placenta, including its basal plate. Maternal vessels in this tissue supply blood to the placental intervillous space.

Alternate Names:
Basal Decidua

Deciduitis

Inflammation of the specialized uterine lining that forms during pregnancy. It may be associated with infection or other pregnancy complications and may occur with pain, fever, or bleeding.

Deciduosis

Pregnancy-related tissue from the uterine lining growing in an unusually large area or outside the uterus, such as on the cervix or pelvic surfaces. It can look like a tumor during examination or surgery but is usually benign.

Deciduous Teeth

The 20 primary teeth that erupt during childhood and are gradually replaced by permanent teeth. Caries, infection, trauma, or premature loss can affect nutrition, speech, space for permanent teeth, and oral development.

Deciduous Tooth

A primary or baby tooth that is eventually shed and replaced by a permanent tooth. Early decay or loss can affect chewing, speech, and the space needed for permanent teeth.

Decision Making

The process of comparing information, options, benefits, risks, and preferences to choose an action or plan, including shared decision-making in healthcare.

Decision-Making Capacity

The ability to understand information about a medical decision, consider the possible results, compare choices, and communicate a choice. It applies to a specific decision, may change over time, and is different from legal competence.

Decitabine

A cancer medicine that changes abnormal gene activity and interferes with growth of blood-forming cancer cells. It is used for selected blood cancers and may cause low blood counts, infection, bleeding, or fatigue.

Declarative Memory

Memory for facts, information, and personal events that a person can consciously remember and describe.

Decoction

A preparation made by simmering plant material in water to extract soluble substances. The strength and safety depend on the plant, preparation, dose, contamination, and interactions with medicines.

Decompensated Cirrhosis

Cirrhosis with complications such as fluid buildup in the abdomen (ascites), bleeding from enlarged veins in the esophagus or stomach, jaundice, or hepatic encephalopathy, which can impair thinking and alertness.

Decomposition

The natural breakdown of a dead body after death. Cells and tissues first break down themselves, followed by the action of microorganisms; the speed and appearance depend on temperature, moisture, and other conditions.

Decompression

Reduction of pressure on a tissue or body compartment, such as removing pressure from a spinal nerve, draining an obstructed organ, or treating pressure changes after diving.

Decompression Sickness

Illness caused by nitrogen bubbles forming in the body when pressure falls too quickly, usually after diving. It may cause joint pain, skin changes, breathing problems, weakness, confusion, or paralysis.

Deconditioning

Loss of strength, fitness, balance, and function after inactivity, illness, or prolonged bed rest. It increases fall risk but can often improve gradually with safe movement, exercise, nutrition, and rehabilitation.

Decongestant

A medicine that reduces swelling inside the nose and relieves nasal congestion. Some oral decongestants can raise blood pressure or speed the heartbeat; prolonged use of some nasal sprays can cause rebound congestion.

Alternate Names:
Decongestants; Nasal Decongestants

Decontamination

Steps that remove or reduce a harmful substance from the skin, eyes, clothing, or digestive tract and prevent further absorption. The correct method depends on the substance; some exposures require washing, irrigation, or specialist treatment.

Decorin

A small protein-sugar molecule found around cells. It helps organize collagen, influences tissue growth and repair, and may affect scar formation.

Decorticate Posture

Abnormal bending of the arms with straightening of the legs, caused by severe injury to the brain. It is a sign of serious brain damage and reduced consciousness.

Decorticate Posturing

Alternate name; see *Decorticate Posture*.

Decorticate Rigidity

Alternate name; see *Decorticate Posture*.

Alternate Names:
Decorticate Posturing; Flexor Posturing

Decreased Alertness

Decreased alertness is reduced awareness or responsiveness that may result from metabolic illness, intoxication, infection, seizure, stroke, trauma, or sleep-related causes.

Decreased Appetite

A pathological or temporary reduction in the desire to ingest food, commonly caused by systemic illness, chronic infection, malignancy, psychological stress, depression, or medications.

Alternate Names:
Anorexia; Hyporexia; Loss of Appetite; Poor Appetite

Decreased Breath Sounds

Softer-than-normal sounds heard when listening to the lungs, suggesting reduced air movement. Causes include fluid or air around the lung, partial lung collapse, blockage, or shallow breathing; sudden one-sided loss can be an emergency.

Decreased Concentration

Reduced ability to sustain attention or mental focus; causes include sleep loss, stress, medications, mood disorders, substance use, and neurologic or medical illness.

Decreased Dentin

Reduced thickness or formation of dentin, the mineralized tissue beneath tooth enamel; causes include developmental defects, wear, erosion, caries, or dental treatment.

Decreased Libido

Reduced sexual desire that may be related to relationships, mood, stress, medications, hormones, chronic illness, pain, or other health factors.

Decreased Tear Production

Lower-than-normal production of the watery part of tears. It can contribute to dry-eye disease, although dry eye can also result from poor tear quality or excessive evaporation.

Decubitus

A lying or reclining position; the term also appears in decubitus ulcer, a pressure injury caused by prolonged pressure and shear.

Decubitus Ulcer

Older term for a pressure injury: damage to skin or underlying tissue caused by sustained pressure, often with shear, usually over a bony area or beneath a medical device. Injury can range from persistent discoloration to an open wound or deeper tissue damage.

Deep

Located farther inside the body or a structure, away

from its surface. For example, deep muscles lie beneath muscles closer to the skin.

Deep Brain Stimulation

A treatment in which implanted electrodes deliver electrical pulses to specific brain targets to reduce symptoms. Common targets include the subthalamic nucleus or globus pallidus for Parkinson disease and dystonia, and the ventral intermediate nucleus of the thalamus for essential tremor.

Deep Femoral Artery

The profunda femoris artery, a major branch of the femoral artery that supplies the deep muscles of the thigh and gives rise to perforating branches.

Deep Infiltrating Endometriosis

Endometriosis that grows deeply into tissues around the uterus, bowel, bladder, or other pelvic structures. It may cause severe period pain, pain with sex or bowel movements, urinary symptoms, infertility, and sometimes requires complex specialist treatment.

Alternate Names:
DIE; Deep Endometriosis

Deep Neck Space Infection

A bacterial infection in one or more of the tissue spaces deep in the neck. It may cause neck swelling, severe throat pain, fever, difficulty swallowing, or breathing problems and can spread to the chest or threaten the airway.

Deep Sleep

The deepest stage of normal non-REM sleep, when a person is difficult to awaken and the body carries out important physical restoration. Too little may contribute to daytime sleepiness and poor function.

Deep Tendon Reflex

An involuntary monosynaptic muscle stretch reflex elicited by briskly tapping a tendon with a reflex hammer. The tap stretches muscle spindles, sending afferent impulses via Ia sensory fibers directly to alpha motor neurons in the spinal cord, producing rapid efferent contraction of the homonymous muscle. Evaluates specific spinal cord segments and peripheral nerve roots: biceps reflex (C5–C6, musculocutaneous nerve), brachioradialis reflex (C6, radial nerve), triceps reflex (C7, radial nerve), patellar reflex (L4, femoral nerve), and Achilles reflex (S1, tibial nerve). Graded clinically on a scale from 0 to 4+ (0: absent; 1+: hypoactive; 2+: normal; 3+: hyperactive without clonus; 4+: hyperactive with sustained clonus). Hypoactive or absent reflexes denote lower motor neuron lesions or peripheral neuropathies; hyperactive reflexes and clonus indicate upper motor neuron lesions with loss of descending cortical inhibition.

Alternate Names:
Deep Tendon Reflexes; Muscle Stretch Reflex; Myotatic Reflex

Deep Tendon Reflexes

Plural form; see *Deep Tendon Reflex*.

Deep Vein Thrombosis

The formation of a blood clot (thrombus) within a deep vein, most commonly deep inside the legs, thighs, or pelvis. It usually develops when blood flow slows down (such as during prolonged bed rest, surgery, or long travel), when the vein wall is damaged, or when a medical condition makes blood clot more easily. Symptoms often include swelling, tenderness, warmth, and aching pain in the affected leg, though some clots cause no symptoms. The primary danger is that a piece of the clot can break loose and travel to the lungs, causing a life-threatening pulmonary embolism.

Alternate Names:
DVT; Deep Venous Thrombosis; Deep Venous Thrombosis (DVT); Phlebothrombosis

Deep Vein Thrombosis Ultrasound

An ultrasound examination that checks whether deep veins compress normally and whether blood flows through them. A vein that does not compress may contain a clot; results are interpreted with symptoms and other tests.

Deep Venous Reflux

Backward flow of blood through weakened valves in

deep veins. It can cause long-term leg swelling, heaviness, skin changes, pain, and ulcers from increased pressure in the veins.

Deerfly Fever

An older name for tularemia, an infection caused by *Francisella tularensis*. It can spread through tick or deerfly bites, infected animals, contaminated water, or inhalation and may cause fever, ulcers, swollen lymph nodes, pneumonia, or severe systemic illness.

De-Escalation

A set of verbal and nonverbal techniques used to reduce agitation and prevent violence while preserving dignity and safety. It includes calm communication, appropriate personal space, clear limits, environmental modification, and offering choices.

Defaecation

The expulsion of stool from the rectum through the anus. Difficulty, pain, urgency, incontinence, bleeding, or a sustained change in bowel habit may indicate constipation, anorectal disease, neurologic dysfunction, or another condition.

Defecation

The process of passing stool from the rectum through the anus. It involves signals from a full rectum, contraction of the bowel, and relaxation of the anal muscles, followed by voluntary control of timing.

Defecation Syncope

Fainting during or immediately after defecation, usually a situational reflex involving straining, reduced venous return, and a temporary fall in blood pressure.

Defecography

An imaging test that records the rectum and pelvic floor while a person passes a soft contrast material. It can show prolapse, a bulge, inward telescoping, or poor coordination causing difficult stool passage.

Defective Virus

A virus missing genetic information needed to reproduce independently. It can multiply only with help from another virus or host system and may influence infection without always causing disease on its own.

Defence Mechanisms

Mental processes that help a person manage conflict, anxiety, or distress, often without conscious awareness. They may be helpful or harmful depending on how rigidly they are used and how they affect daily life.

Defense Mechanism

An automatic, involuntary psychological process operating largely outside conscious awareness to mediate between internal instinctual drives (id), external reality, and moral conscience (superego), shielding the individual from severe anxiety, guilt, or psychic distress. Categorized systematically by George Vaillant into four developmental levels: pathological/psychotic defenses (delusional projection, denial, psychotic distortion); immature defenses (acting out, passive-aggressive behavior, projection, splitting, fantasy); neurotic defenses (displacement, dissociation, intellectualization, isolation of affect, rationalization, reaction formation, repression); and mature defenses (altruism, anticipation, humor, sublimation, suppression), which are associated with healthy psychosocial adaptation.

Alternate Names:
Defense Mechanisms; Ego Defenses

Defense Mechanisms

Plural form; see *Defense Mechanism*.

Defenses

The body's protective mechanisms against infection, injury, and other threats, including physical barriers and immune responses.

Alternate Names:
Host Defenses; Immune Defenses

Defense Wounds

Injuries to the hands, wrists, arms, or other ar-

eas that may occur when a person tries to protect against an attack. Their appearance and location can support a forensic interpretation but cannot prove how an injury happened by themselves.

Defensin

A small protective protein made by skin, lining tissues, and immune cells. It can damage microbes and is part of the body's early defense against infection.

Deferasirox

An oral iron-chelating medicine used to reduce chronic iron overload when clinically indicated; kidney, liver, hearing, and gastrointestinal toxicity require monitoring.

Deferiprone

An oral iron chelator used for transfusional iron overload; neutropenia or agranulocytosis is an important adverse effect requiring blood-count monitoring.

Deferoxamine

A parenteral iron chelator used for severe or chronic iron overload and sometimes aluminum toxicity; treatment requires monitoring for ocular, auditory, renal, and infectious complications.

Defibrillation

Delivery of an electrical shock to stop ventricular fibrillation or pulseless ventricular tachycardia during cardiac arrest. The shock can restore an organized rhythm and is used with cardiopulmonary resuscitation.

Defibrillator

A device that delivers an electrical shock to treat certain life-threatening abnormal heart rhythms. External defibrillators are used during cardiac arrest; implanted devices can detect and treat dangerous rhythms automatically.

Defibrillator Implant

An implanted device that continuously monitors heart rhythm and can use pacing or an electrical shock to stop dangerous fast rhythms. It may be recommended for selected people at high risk of sudden cardiac arrest.

Deficiency Diseases

Illnesses caused by too little of a needed nutrient or other substance, such as iron, iodine, vitamin D, or vitamin B12. Symptoms depend on the missing substance.

Deficient Color Vision

Alternate name; see *Color Blindness*.

Deformation

An alteration in the shape or structure of a body part, tissue, or material caused by developmental forces, injury, disease, pressure, or mechanical stress.

Deformity

An abnormal shape, alignment, or structure of a body part caused by development, injury, disease, pressure, or unusual growth. It may affect appearance, movement, comfort, or organ function.

Degarelix

An injected hormone-blocking medicine that rapidly lowers testosterone. It is used for advanced prostate cancer; injection-site reactions, hot flushes, bone loss, and other hormone-related effects may occur.

Degeneration

Progressive structural or functional deterioration of cells, tissues, or organs caused by aging, disease, injury, inherited factors, or other processes.

Degenerative

Describing gradual deterioration or loss of structure or function in a tissue or organ. The term does not by itself specify the cause, rate of change, or whether the damage is reversible.

Degenerative Arthritis

Alternate index label; see *Osteoarthritis*.

Degenerative Cervical Myelopathy

Spinal-cord dysfunction caused by age-related

changes in the neck that narrow the spinal canal and compress the cord. It may cause hand numbness or clumsiness, limb weakness, balance or walking problems, and sometimes bladder or bowel changes; worsening symptoms can reflect progressive cord compression.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Spondylotic Myelopathy; DCM

Degenerative Chorea

Progressive involuntary, dance-like movements caused by degeneration of brain circuits that control movement. The term is most often used for chorea associated with Huntington disease, which can also affect thinking, mood, behavior, speech, and swallowing.

Degenerative Disc

Age-related or other structural changes in a spinal disc, such as drying or loss of height. These changes may occur without symptoms or contribute to back or neck pain and nerve compression.

Alternate Names:
DDD; Degenerative Disc Disease

Degenerative Disc Disease

Wear, drying, or cracking of the cushioning discs between spinal bones, often related to aging or injury. It may cause back or neck pain, stiffness, or nerve pressure; imaging changes can occur without symptoms.

Degenerative Disease

A broad term for a condition in which tissue or organ structure or function progressively worsens. Causes differ by disease and include aging, inherited changes, and ongoing injury; examples include osteoarthritis and some disorders of the brain and nerves. It is not one specific diagnosis.

Degenerative Disk Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Degenerative Disc*.

Degenerative Disorder

A disease in which progressive cellular or tissue deterioration causes loss of structure or function, as in neurodegenerative, joint, retinal, or muscle disorders.

Degenerative Joint Disease

Gradual loss of joint cartilage with changes in nearby bone and tissues, commonly meaning osteoarthritis. It can cause pain, stiffness, swelling, reduced movement, and difficulty with daily activities.

Alternate Names:
Osteoarthritis

Degenerative Rotator-Cuff Disorders

A group of shoulder problems that develop from gradual degeneration of the rotator-cuff tendons, often associated with aging or repeated use. They include tendon degeneration and partial or complete tears. They may cause shoulder pain or weakness, but some degenerative tears cause no symptoms.

Degenerative Spine Disease

Wear-related changes in the spinal discs, joints, or bones that can cause back or neck pain, stiffness, reduced movement, or pressure on nerves. Symptoms may include leg or arm pain, numbness, weakness, or walking difficulty.

Degenerative Spondylolisthesis

Forward slipping of one spinal bone over another because joints and disks have worn down, sometimes causing back pain, leg pain, or nerve compression.

Deglutition

The coordinated process of moving food, liquid, or saliva from the mouth through the throat and esophagus into the stomach. Problems can cause choking, coughing, or food entering the airway.

Alternate Names:
Swallowing

Degos Disease (Malignant Atrophic Papulosis)

A rare occlusive small-vessel disease causing multiple porcelain-white, atrophic skin papules with a surrounding pink or violaceous rim. It may remain

limited to the skin or involve the intestine, brain, or other organs; systemic involvement may cause abdominal pain, headache, or neurologic symptoms.

Degranulation

Release of stored chemicals from cells such as mast cells, white blood cells, and platelets. The chemicals help respond to injury or infection but can also cause allergy, inflammation, blood-vessel changes, or clotting.

Degrees Fahrenheit

A unit on the Fahrenheit temperature scale. In clinical care, body temperature may be reported in Fahrenheit; 98.6 degrees Fahrenheit is an approximate average normal oral temperature, not a universal threshold.

Dehiscence

Partial or complete separation of a healing wound or surgical closure. It may involve only the skin or deeper tissues; increasing pain, drainage, or exposed tissue can indicate wound complications.

DEHP

Di(2-ethylhexyl) phthalate, a chemical added to some plastics to make them flexible. Repeated or high exposure may affect reproduction, development, or hormone function, so medical exposure is limited when possible.

Dehydration

Loss of more water and electrolytes than are replaced, often from vomiting, diarrhea, fever, sweating, or poor fluid intake. It can cause thirst, dry mouth, reduced urination, dizziness, fast heartbeat, abnormal electrolyte levels, or shock.

Dehydroascorbic Acid

The oxidized form of vitamin C. Cells can take it up and convert it back to active vitamin C, allowing it to participate in antioxidant and other chemical reactions.

Dehydroepiandrosterone

A hormone made mainly by the adrenal glands that the body can convert into other sex hormones. Levels change with age and illness; supplements may cause acne, unwanted hair, mood changes, or medicine interactions.

Deinstitutionalize

To help a person leave long-term institutional care and live in the community with suitable housing, healthcare, and support. The plan should protect safety, treatment needs, and independence.

Deiodinase

An enzyme that removes iodine from thyroid hormones and changes how active they are. Different tissues use these enzymes to help control metabolism, growth, brain development, and responses to thyroid hormone.

Deja Vu

Alternate spelling; see *Déjà Vu*.

Déjà Vu

A brief feeling that a new situation has happened before. Occasional episodes are common. Repeated episodes with loss of awareness or unusual movements may occur with seizures.

Dejerine-Roussy Syndrome

Persistent burning, aching, or painful abnormal sensation on one side of the body after a stroke damages a deep brain sensory area. Normally harmless touch or temperature may become painful.

De Lange Syndrome

A congenital developmental disorder, also called Cornelia de Lange syndrome, involving characteristic facial features, growth and developmental delay, limb abnormalities of variable severity, and intellectual disability.

Alternate Names:
Cornelia De Lange Syndrome

Delavirdine

An older HIV medicine that blocks reverse transcriptase, an enzyme HIV needs to copy its genetic material. It was used with other HIV medicines, but resistance and drug interactions limit its use.

Delayed Cord Clamping

Waiting, commonly 30–60 seconds or longer, before clamping the umbilical cord after birth. This allows extra blood to reach the newborn and may improve early circulation and iron stores; timing depends on both patients' condition.

Delayed Ejaculation

Persistent difficulty or inability to ejaculate despite adequate sexual stimulation, causing distress. Medicines, nerve or hormone problems, chronic illness, psychological factors, and relationship circumstances may contribute.

Delayed Emergence

Failure to wake and respond as expected after anesthesia. Causes include lingering anesthetic medicines, low body temperature, abnormal blood sugar or salts, breathing problems, stroke, or other complications.

Delayed Gastric Emptying

Alternate index label; see *Gastroparesis*.

Delayed Graft Function

Poor early function of a transplanted kidney, usually related to ischemia-reperfusion injury. In studies it is often defined as needing dialysis within the first seven days after transplant, although definitions vary.

Alternate Names:
DGF

Delayed Growth

Slower-than-expected increase in a child's height, weight, or head size. Nutrition, chronic disease, hormone problems, genetic conditions, and family growth pattern can contribute; growth patterns are evaluated over time.

Delayed Hemolytic Transfusion Reaction

Immune destruction of transfused red blood cells that develops more than 24 hours and up to 28 days after transfusion. It usually occurs when a recipient's antibody response to a red-cell antigen rises again and may cause jaundice or an unexpected fall in hemoglobin.

Alternate Names:
DHTR

Delayed Hypersensitivity

An immune reaction that develops hours or days after exposure rather than immediately. It can cause contact dermatitis, some medicine rashes, or a reaction to a tuberculosis skin test.

Delayed or Absent Tooth Formation

Delayed or absent tooth formation means teeth develop or erupt later than expected or fail to form, due to local, genetic, endocrine, nutritional, or systemic causes.

Delayed Orgasm

Persistent difficulty or inability to reach orgasm despite adequate stimulation, causing distress. Medicines, illness, hormonal or nerve problems, anxiety, trauma, and relationship factors may contribute.

Delayed Puberty

Puberty that has not begun by the expected age or is progressing unusually slowly. Common thresholds are no breast development by age 13 in girls or no testicular enlargement by age 14 in boys. Primary amenorrhea is defined by absent menstruation by age 15 or more than three years after breast development. Causes include constitutional delay, chronic illness, undernutrition, and gonadal or hypothalamic-pituitary disorders.

Delayed Puberty In Boys

Failure of testicular enlargement, the first usual sign of puberty in boys, by age 14. Causes include constitutional delay, chronic illness, undernutrition, primary testicular disorders, or impaired hypothalamic-pituitary signaling. Slowed or arrested pubertal

progression is also abnormal.

Delayed Puberty In Girls

Failure of breast development by age 13, or absent menstruation by age 15 or more than three years after breast development. Causes include constitutional delay, low energy availability, chronic illness, ovarian insufficiency, or impaired hypothalamic-pituitary signaling. Puberty that stops progressing may also indicate an underlying disorder.

Delayed Sleep Phase

A body-clock pattern in which a person naturally falls asleep and wakes much later than desired. Sleep may be normal at the preferred times but interfere with school, work, or social activities.

Alternate Names:
Delayed Sleep-Wake Phase Disorder (DSWPD); Delayed Sleep Phase Syndrome (DSPS)

Delayed Sleep Phase Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Delayed Sleep Phase*.

Delayed Sleep-Wake Phase Sleep Disorder

Alternate name; see *Delayed Sleep Phase*.

Deletion

Loss of a section of DNA or part of a chromosome. The effects depend on the size, location, and genes involved; deletions may cause no problems or lead to inherited, developmental, or medical disorders.

Deletion Mutation

A genetic change in which one or more DNA building blocks are missing. Its effect depends on the location and size of the deletion and whether it changes a gene or its control region.

Delftia

A group of oxygen-using bacteria found mainly in soil and water. Human infection is uncommon but can occur as an opportunistic infection, especially in people with weakened immunity or medical devices.

Delirium

A sudden, temporary state of severe mental confusion and fluctuating awareness. Unlike dementia, which develops slowly over months or years, delirium comes on quickly—over hours or days—and symptoms often worsen at night. It is caused by an underlying medical problem such as an acute infection, medication reaction or withdrawal, dehydration, surgery, or organ failure. Common signs include trouble paying attention, disorientation, disordered thinking, memory loss, and hallucinations or agitation.

Delirium In Anesthesia

Sudden confusion, poor attention, and changing awareness during recovery from anesthesia or surgery. Possible causes include medicines, infection, pain, low oxygen, dehydration, or abnormal body chemistry.

Delirium Superimposed On Dementia

Delirium occurring in a person who already has dementia. The sudden, fluctuating worsening in attention and awareness differs from the person's usual cognitive impairment and may be triggered by illness, medicines, dehydration, or hospitalization.

Delirium Tremens

A severe, life-threatening form of alcohol withdrawal that occurs in people with long-standing heavy alcohol dependence when they abruptly stop drinking, usually developing two to four days after the last drink. Because the nervous system has adapted to constant alcohol exposure, sudden withdrawal triggers extreme nervous system overactivity. Symptoms include severe mental confusion, shaking (tremors), high fever, heavy sweating, elevated heart rate and blood pressure, extreme agitation, and vivid hallucinations.

Delirium Tremens (DTs)

A severe, potentially fatal form of alcohol withdrawal characterized by delirium, agitation, tremor, autonomic overactivity, hallucinations, and sometimes seizures, usually beginning several days after reduction or cessation of heavy drinking.

Delivery

Childbirth, ending with birth of the baby and delivery of the placenta. It may occur through the vagina, sometimes with forceps or vacuum assistance, or through cesarean surgery.

Delivery Of Posterior Arm

A maneuver for shoulder dystocia in which the clinician brings the baby's back arm through the birth canal. This reduces the width of the shoulders and may help complete delivery.

Delivery Presentations

The fetal body part positioned to enter the birth canal first. Common presentations are head-first, breech, and shoulder; the presentation affects delivery planning and risks.

Delta Agent

An older name for hepatitis D virus, which can reproduce only when hepatitis B virus is present. Infection may cause severe acute hepatitis or worsen long-term liver disease.

Delta-ALA Urine Test

A urine test measuring a substance used to make hemoglobin. Increased levels may occur with acute porphyria or lead poisoning and are interpreted with symptoms and other tests.

Deltacoronavirus

A group of coronaviruses identified by their genetic features. Some infect birds or mammals, and their ability to infect people or cause disease depends on the specific virus and host.

Deltaretrovirus

A group of viruses that includes human T-cell leukemia viruses. They copy their RNA into DNA inside infected cells; some can persist for years and cause blood-cell disorders or cancer.

Delta-Tocopherol

One form of vitamin E found in foods and supplements. It has antioxidant activity, but alpha-tocopherol is the main form maintained in human blood and used to assess vitamin E status.

Delta Waves

Very slow electrical brain waves that are normal during deep non-REM sleep. Excessive delta activity while awake may indicate brain dysfunction; significance depends on symptoms and other tests.

Alternate Names:
Delta Rhythm

Deltoid

The large, triangular muscle covering the shoulder. It helps lift the arm and stabilize the shoulder joint; injury or nerve damage can cause pain and weakness.

Deltoid Ligament

A strong, fan-shaped triangular ligament complex on the medial aspect of the ankle joint, composed of superficial and deep components originating from the medial malleolus and attaching to the talus, calcaneus, and navicular bones to resist excessive eversion.

Alternate Names:
Medial Collateral Ligament of the Ankle

Deltoid Muscle

A triangular shoulder muscle attached to the collarbone, shoulder blade, and upper arm. Its front, middle, and back fibers move the arm forward, outward, and backward; the axillary nerve supplies it.

Delusion

A firmly held false belief that remains despite clear evidence to the contrary and is not explained by the person's cultural background. It may involve persecution, grandiosity, illness, or other themes.

Delusional Disorder

A mental disorder with one or more persistent delusions lasting at least one month, while overall functioning is relatively preserved. Hallucinations, if present, relate closely to the delusional belief.

Delusional Infestation

A fixed belief that the body is infested by a living agent, such as a parasite, or by nonliving material, such as fibers, despite lack of objective evidence of infestation. It may occur as a primary delusional disorder or secondary to a psychiatric, neurologic, medical, medication-related, or substance-related condition.

Demarcation

A clear boundary between two areas or conditions, such as the line separating healthy tissue from tissue that has died. It may guide diagnosis or treatment.

Demeclocycline

A tetracycline antibiotic that blocks bacterial protein production. It was also used to reduce excess water retention in some patients with inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion; adverse effects include sun sensitivity and kidney or liver problems.

Demecolcine

A colchicine-related substance that disrupts microtubules, structures needed for cell division. It has limited medical use and can be highly toxic, causing gastrointestinal, blood-cell, nerve, or organ injury.

Dementia

A lasting decline in memory, thinking, language, judgment, or other mental abilities that interferes with independent daily life. Causes include brain diseases, blood-vessel disease, infections, medicines, and some treatable medical problems.

Alternate Names:
Major Neurocognitive Disorder

Dementia And Driving

The effect of cognitive impairment on driving safety. Assessment considers memory, judgment, visuospatial skills, reaction time, medications, and local licensing requirements.

Dementia Behavioral and Sleep Changes

Changes in behavior or sleep that can occur with dementia, including agitation, wandering, altered sleep timing, or increased confusion later in the day. Causes and patterns vary; these changes are not unique to dementia.

Dementia Due To Metabolic Causes

Cognitive impairment caused or worsened by metabolic problems such as thyroid disease, vitamin deficiency, organ failure, electrolyte disturbance, or medication toxicity; some causes are treatable.

Dementia with Lewy Bodies

Alternate name; see *Lewy Body Dementia*.

Alternate Names:
DLB; Lewy Body Dementia

Demethylation

Removal of a small chemical group called a methyl group from a molecule such as DNA or a protein. In DNA, this change can alter which genes are active and affect cell development or disease.

Demineralization

Loss of minerals from a tissue such as tooth enamel or bone. It can weaken the tissue, causing early tooth decay or contributing to fragile bones, depending on the cause.

Demulcent

A substance that coats and soothes irritated moist body linings, temporarily reducing discomfort from dryness, inflammation, or minor injury.

De Musset Sign

Repeated head nodding that matches the heartbeat. It can occur when the aortic valve leaks severely, but it is uncommon and cannot confirm the diagnosis without examination and heart tests.

Demyelinating CNS Disease

A disorder in which the protective covering of nerves in the brain, spinal cord, or vision pathways is damaged. Causes include immune disease, infection, inherited conditions, toxins, and metabolic problems.

Demyelinating Disease

A disease in which the protective covering around nerve fibers is damaged. Nerve signals then slow or fail, causing problems such as weakness, numbness, vision changes, or poor coordination.

Demyelination

Loss or damage of myelin, the protective coating that helps nerve fibers send signals quickly. It can disrupt movement, sensation, vision, balance, or thinking and may result from immune, infectious, inherited, or toxic disorders.

Denaturant

A substance added to another product to change its taste, smell, or properties, often to make it unsuitable for drinking. Some denaturants are poisonous or irritating, so health effects depend on the product and amount swallowed or contacted.

Dendrite

A branching extension of a nerve cell that receives signals from other nerve cells or sensory receptors and carries those signals toward the cell body.

Dendrites

Plural form; see *Dendrite*.

Dendritic Cell

An immune cell that captures foreign material and shows pieces of it to other immune cells. This helps start a targeted immune response against infections and abnormal cells.

Dendritic Cells

Plural form; see *Dendritic Cell*.

Dendritic Spine

A tiny branch on a nerve cell that receives signals from other nerve cells. Its shape and number can change with learning, development, and some brain diseases.

Dendritic Ulcer

A branching epithelial ulcer of the cornea, classically caused by herpes simplex virus. It may cause a red eye, pain, light sensitivity, tearing, or reduced vision and requires ophthalmic assessment.

Denervate

To remove or interrupt the nerve supply to a tissue or organ, either deliberately during treatment or because of injury or disease. The change may reduce movement, sensation, pain, or automatic organ function.

Denervation

Denervation is loss of nerve supply to a muscle or tissue, causing weakness, atrophy, altered sensation, or autonomic dysfunction.

Dengue

A viral infection spread mainly by infected *Aedes* mosquitoes. It commonly causes sudden fever, severe headache, pain behind the eyes, muscle and joint aches, nausea, and sometimes a rash. Severe dengue can cause plasma leakage, bleeding, shock, or organ injury. NS1 antigen, nucleic-acid, or antibody tests support diagnosis depending on illness timing; aspirin and other nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs increase bleeding risk.

Alternate Names:
Breakbone Fever; DENV Infection

Dengue Fever

Alternate name; see *Dengue*.

Dengue Hemorrhagic Fever

An older dengue classification for illness with plasma leakage and hemorrhagic manifestations, which could progress to shock. Current World Health Organization classification groups clinically severe cases as severe dengue and separately identifies warning signs.

Dengue Shock Syndrome

An older classification term for shock caused by severe dengue, usually from plasma leakage and reduced circulating blood volume. Current World Health Organization classification uses the category severe dengue.

Dengue Virus

The virus that causes dengue fever and is spread mainly by infected Aedes mosquitoes. Four major types exist; protection after infection is strongest against the same type and does not reliably prevent later infection by other types.

Denial

A psychological response in which a person cannot or will not accept a distressing fact, diagnosis, or situation. It may briefly reduce distress but can delay needed decisions or treatment when persistent.

Denileukin Diftitox

A laboratory-made protein combining part of interleukin-2 with diphtheria toxin. It was used for selected cutaneous T-cell lymphomas by delivering the toxin to cells bearing the interleukin-2 receptor; toxicity limits use.

Dennie-Morgan Fold

A prominent, symmetrical single or double skin crease or infraorbital fold immediately below the margin of the lower eyelid, recognized as a characteristic cutaneous hallmark of atopic dermatitis and allergic diathesis.

Alternate Names:
Dennie-Morgan Line; Dennie Fold

Denominator

The number below the line in a fraction. In a medical rate or proportion, it represents the total population or group being compared with the number above it.

Denosumab

A medicine that blocks a protein needed to activate bone-destroying cells. It is used for osteoporosis and some cancer-related bone problems; stopping it without follow-up can cause rapid bone loss and spine fractures.

Denosumab For Osteoporosis

An injection given every six months that blocks a signal activating bone-destroying cells. It lowers fracture risk, including at the spine and hip; low calcium and rapid bone loss after stopping are recognized risks.

De Novo

Newly arising in an individual rather than inherited from either parent; the term is commonly used for genetic variants or disease presentations.

De Novo Variant

A genetic change found in a person that was not found in either biological parent. It usually begins in an egg, sperm, or very early embryo and may cause disease; testing parents can help estimate the chance in future pregnancies.

Dens

The tooth-shaped projection of the second neck vertebra. It fits into the first neck vertebra and acts as a pivot that allows the head to turn.

Dens Evaginatus

An extra bump or cusp on a tooth, most often a premolar. It may contain an extension of the tooth's nerve and can wear, break, or develop decay and pain.

Dens Invaginatus

An inward folding of a tooth's enamel and dentin that may reach the nerve. The pocket can trap bacteria and food, increasing the risk of early decay, nerve infection, and tooth loss.

Densitometry

Measurement of how dense a tissue is, most often the mineral content of bone. A bone-density scan helps diagnose osteoporosis, estimate fracture risk, and monitor treatment.

Density

The amount of mass in a given volume. In medicine, density measurements help describe bone mineral content, tissue composition, fluid collections, or findings on imaging.

Dental Abscess

A pocket of pus caused by infection in a tooth or nearby gum. It may cause toothache, swelling, fever, or trouble opening the mouth. The infection can spread to the face or neck and, rarely, block breathing.

Dental Age

An estimate of a child's developmental age based on tooth formation, hardening, and eruption. It can help assess growth but does not exactly determine the child's actual age.

Dental Alloy

A mixture of metals used to make dental fillings, crowns, bridges, dentures, orthodontic appliances, or other restorations. Its strength, appearance, corrosion resistance, and possible allergies depend on its composition.

Dental Alveolus

The part of the upper or lower jawbone that forms a tooth socket and holds the tooth root. It can shrink after tooth loss or severe gum disease.

Dental Amalgam

A durable filling material made by mixing liquid mercury with powdered metals, mainly silver, tin, and copper. It is strong but has a silver color and may be unsuitable in some situations.

Dental Anesthesia

Use of local anesthetic, sedation, or occasionally general anesthesia to prevent pain or reduce anxiety during dental treatment. The method depends on the procedure, health, age, and patient preference.

Dental Anxiety

Fear or distress about dental treatment that may cause avoidance, delayed care, or difficulty during appointments. Reassurance, communication, pain control, and behavioral or medicine-based support may help.

Dental Arch

The curved arrangement of teeth and the bone supporting them in the upper or lower jaw. Its shape affects tooth alignment, bite, speech, chewing, and space for dental restorations.

Dental Articulator

A device that holds models of the upper and lower teeth and imitates jaw movements. It helps dental professionals design and adjust crowns, bridges, dentures, and other restorations so they fit the bite.

Dental Avulsion

Complete displacement of a tooth from its socket, usually caused by trauma. Avulsion of a permanent tooth is a time-sensitive dental emergency because prolonged drying damages the periodontal ligament; primary teeth are not replanted.

Dental Bone Graft

Surgery that adds bone or a bone-like material to the jaw. It may rebuild a thin area of jawbone or prepare the jaw for a dental implant.

Alternate Names:
Alveolar Ridge Augmentation; Maxillofacial Bone Grafting

Dental Braces

Fixed or removable appliances that apply gentle, controlled force to move teeth and improve their alignment or bite. Cleaning and periodic adjustment are part of treatment; possible problems include soreness, decay, gum disease, and root shortening.

Alternate Names:
Orthodontic Braces; Orthodontic Appliances

Dental Bridge

A fixed dental appliance that replaces one or more missing teeth by attaching artificial teeth to nearby teeth or implants. It can improve chewing and appearance and depends on healthy supporting teeth or implants.

Dental Calculus

Hardened plaque formed when minerals in saliva or

gum fluid collect on teeth. It cannot be removed reliably by brushing alone and can contribute to gum inflammation and disease.

Dental Caries

Tooth decay that happens when bacteria in plaque use sugars to make acids that weaken and wear away a tooth. It can cause holes, sensitivity, pain, infection, or tooth loss.

Alternate Names:
Tooth Decay

Dental Cavities

Permanent holes or weakened areas caused when plaque bacteria use sugars and make acids that dissolve a tooth. Decay can spread from enamel into the deeper tooth, causing sensitivity, pain, infection, or tooth loss.

Dental Cement

A dental material used to attach crowns, bridges, or orthodontic bands, fill small spaces, or protect exposed tooth tissue. Its strength and use depend on the material and treatment.

Dental Ceramic

A tooth-colored material used for crowns, veneers, bridges, fillings, and implant restorations. It provides good appearance and resistance to wear, but its strength and suitability vary by type and location.

Dental Clasp

A part of a removable partial denture that rests against or around supporting teeth to help keep the denture in place. Poor fit or excessive pressure can irritate teeth or gums.

Dental Crown

A custom-fabricated, full-coverage prosthetic dental restoration cemented over the prepared coronal portion of a damaged, decayed, fractured, or endodontically treated tooth. It encases the visible tooth structure down to the gingival margin, restoring natural anatomical contour, occlusal masticatory function, structural durability, and aesthetics. Fabricated from diverse materials, including all-ceramic/porcelain (e.g., lithium disilicate, zirconia), porcelain-fused-to-metal (PFM), and cast metal alloys (gold or base metals).

Dental Crowns

Plural form; see *Dental Crown*.

Dental Deposit

Material that collects on a tooth, such as plaque, hardened tartar, food debris, or stain. Some deposits irritate the gums or support decay and may require professional cleaning.

Dental Disease

A disorder of the teeth, gums, jaw, or supporting tissues, including decay, gum disease, infection, and tooth loss. Fluoride, daily cleaning, limited frequent sugar exposure, and dental visits reduce risk.

Dental Drill

A powered dental handpiece with a rotating bur, driven by air or an electric motor, used to remove decayed tooth structure, shape teeth, prepare teeth for fillings or crowns, and perform other dental procedures. Different burs and speeds are selected for the material and procedure.

Alternate Names:
Dental Handpiece

Dental Dysplasia

Abnormal development of a tooth or its supporting tissue. It may change the tooth's shape, color, strength, position, or eruption and can increase the risk of wear, decay, or infection.

Dental Erosion

Gradual loss of tooth enamel caused by acid rather than bacteria. Acidic foods or drinks, reflux, vomiting, and some medicines may contribute, causing sensitivity or worn teeth; reducing acid exposure helps prevent progression.

Dental Extraction

Removal of a tooth from its jaw socket because

of severe decay, infection, gum disease, impaction, crowding, trauma, or treatment planning. Risks include bleeding, infection, nerve injury, fracture, and dry socket.

Dental Fillings

Materials placed in a tooth after decay or damage is removed to restore its shape and function. Resin, glass ionomer, metal amalgam, or other materials may be used depending on the tooth and clinical situation.

Dental Fissure

A narrow natural groove or developmental defect in a tooth, especially on a chewing surface. Food and bacteria can collect there, increasing the risk of decay.

Dental Floss

A thin thread used to remove plaque and food between teeth and just below the gumline. Daily cleaning between teeth helps prevent gum inflammation but does not replace brushing or dental care.

Dental Fluorosis

Changes in tooth enamel caused by too much fluoride while the teeth are developing. It may appear as white lines or patches and, in more severe cases, brown discoloration or pits.

Dental Hygiene

Daily care of the teeth, gums, tongue, and mouth, including brushing with fluoride toothpaste and cleaning between teeth. It removes plaque and helps prevent decay, gum disease, and bad breath.

Dental Implant

A small biocompatible fixture placed in the jawbone to support a replacement tooth, bridge, or denture. Bone may grow around it for stability; risks include infection, poor healing, nerve injury, and implant failure.

Dental Implantation

The surgical insertion of an artificial titanium screw or post into the jawbone to serve as a sturdy anchor for a replacement tooth or crown; see *Dental Implant*.

Dental Impression Material

A material placed in a tray to make an accurate mold of the teeth and mouth tissues. The mold helps make crowns, dentures, orthodontic appliances, restorations, or study models.

Dental Injuries

Damage to teeth, gums, jawbone, or mouth tissues caused by a fall, blow, sports injury, accident, or biting force. Prompt assessment may save displaced or knocked-out teeth; severe bleeding or head injury is an emergency.

Alternate Names:
Traumatic Dental Injury

Dental Inlay

A custom-made filling fitted inside the grooves of a damaged tooth and bonded in place. It restores areas too large for a simple filling but does not cover the tooth's cusps like an onlay or crown.

Dental Material

A substance used in dental care, such as composite, amalgam, ceramic, metal, cement, bonding material, impression material, or implant material. Choice depends on the treatment, location, strength, appearance, and patient factors.

Dental Occlusion

The way the upper and lower teeth meet when the mouth closes or the jaw moves. An abnormal bite may contribute to difficulty chewing, tooth wear, jaw pain, or muscle strain.

Dental Overjet

The horizontal distance between the upper and lower front teeth when the teeth are closed. A large overjet may increase the risk of trauma to the upper front teeth and affect biting.

Dental Papilla

Soft embryonic tissue beneath a developing tooth. Its cells form the dentin and living pulp, which contains the tooth's nerves and blood vessels.

Dental Pellicle

A thin protective film of salivary proteins that forms on tooth enamel soon after cleaning. Bacteria can attach to it and build dental plaque.

Dental Plaque

A sticky film of bacteria, saliva, and food material on teeth and along the gums. If not removed by brushing and cleaning between teeth, it can cause decay, gum inflammation, and gum disease.

Dental Polishing

Cleaning and smoothing tooth surfaces, often after tartar has been removed. It can remove some surface stains but does not repair tooth decay or gum disease.

Alternate Names:
Coronal Polish

Dental Porcelain

A tooth-colored ceramic used for crowns, veneers, bridges, and other restorations. It provides a natural appearance but may chip or fracture under heavy force.

Dental Precision Attachment

A precision mechanical or magnetic interlocking device used to secure, stabilize, and retain a removable partial denture or overdenture to retained tooth roots, natural abutments, or dental implants.

Alternate Names:
Precision Attachment

Dental Procedure

An examination, preventive service, or treatment involving the teeth, gums, jaw, or mouth, such as cleaning, filling, extraction, root-canal treatment, or restoration. Benefits and risks depend on the procedure.

Dental Prosthesis

An artificial replacement for one or more missing teeth or nearby mouth tissues, such as a denture, bridge, crown, or implant-supported restoration. It restores appearance, speech, and chewing.

Dental Public Health

Efforts to prevent and control oral disease in communities. They include fluoride programs, oral-health education, screening, disease monitoring, access to dental care, and policies that reduce differences in oral health.

Dental Pulp

The living soft tissue at the center of a tooth. It contains nerves, blood vessels, and connective tissue and can become inflamed or infected when decay or injury reaches it.

Dental Pulpitis

Inflammation of the soft tissue inside a tooth, commonly caused by decay, trauma, a crack, or dental treatment. Brief pain may be reversible; spontaneous or lingering pain may require root-canal treatment or extraction.

Dental Pulp Necrosis

Death of the soft tissue inside a tooth, usually after untreated inflammation, deep decay, trauma, or loss of blood supply. The tooth may become discolored and develop infection around its root.

Dental Radiographs

X-ray images of the teeth and jaws used to find decay, bone loss, infection, impacted teeth, fractures, and developmental problems. Types include bitewing, periapical, occlusal, and panoramic views.

Dental Radiography

Use of X-rays to examine teeth and jaws. Bitewing, periapical, panoramic, and three-dimensional scans answer different questions; exposure is kept as low as reasonably achievable while obtaining useful images.

Dental Restorative Materials

Materials used to repair teeth, including composite resin, glass ionomer, amalgam, ceramic, and metal alloys. Selection depends on tooth location, size of damage, strength, appearance, moisture control, cost, and patient needs.

Dental Root

The part of a tooth below the gum that anchors it in the jawbone. It contains a canal with nerves and blood vessels and is covered by cementum and supported by a ligament. Infection, decay, cracks, or loss of bone around the root can cause pain and tooth loosening.

Dental Sac

A layer of tissue surrounding a developing tooth. It forms the tissues that support the tooth, including the periodontal ligament, cementum, and part of the surrounding jawbone.

Dental Screening

A check of the teeth, gums, and mouth to look for decay, gum disease, oral lesions, or risk factors before serious symptoms develop. Screening does not replace a complete dental examination.

Dental Sealant

A thin protective coating placed in the grooves of teeth, especially molars. It blocks food and bacteria from collecting in deep pits and lowers the risk of decay.

Dental Sealants

Plural form; see *Dental Sealant*.

Dental Sleep Apnea Therapy

Alternate name; see *Oral Appliance Therapy*.

Dental Splint

A dental device used to support, protect, or immobilize loose, replanted, fractured, or injured teeth while they heal. The term can also refer to removable appliances used to protect teeth from grinding or to support treatment of jaw disorders.

Alternate Names:
Trauma Splint; Tooth Splint

Dental Trauma

Alternate name; see *Dental Injuries*.

Dental Traumatology

The prevention, assessment, and treatment of injuries to teeth and surrounding mouth tissues. Injuries may involve cracks, fractures, displacement, root damage, or complete tooth loss.

Dental X-Ray

Radiographic imaging of the teeth, gums, and jawbones; see *Dental X-Rays*.

Dental X-Rays

X-ray images of teeth and jaws used to detect decay, bone loss, infection, impacted teeth, fractures, developmental problems, and other disease not visible during an examination.

Dentate Gyrus

A curved region of the hippocampus that helps process incoming information and form memories. Studies suggest that new neurons may form there in adulthood, including in humans, but the extent and functional importance of adult human hippocampal neurogenesis remain debated.

Dentate Line

A zigzag transverse anatomical boundary in the anal canal separating the upper two-thirds (endodermal origin, simple columnar epithelium, autonomic visceral innervation) from the lower one-third (ectodermal origin, stratified squamous epithelium, somatic pudendal innervation).

Alternate Names:
Pectinate Line

Dentatorubral-Pallidoluysian Atrophy

A rare inherited brain disorder caused by an extra-long repeated section of the ATN1 gene. Symptoms vary with age and may include seizures, poor coordination, involuntary movements, behavior changes,

and worsening thinking ability.

Alternate Names:
DRPLA; Haw River Syndrome; Naito-Oyanagi Disease

Dent Disease

An inherited disorder of the kidney's filtering tubes, usually affecting boys. It causes loss of small proteins in urine, excess urinary calcium, kidney stones or calcium deposits, and sometimes progressive kidney failure.

Dentifrice

A preparation, such as toothpaste or tooth powder, used to clean teeth. Fluoride dentifrice strengthens enamel and helps prevent tooth decay when used regularly.

Dentigerous Cyst

A fluid-filled sac that forms around the crown of an unerupted tooth, usually in the jaw. It may cause swelling, move nearby teeth, or damage bone if it becomes large or infected.

Dentin

The hard tissue beneath tooth enamel that forms most of the tooth. Tiny channels within it can transmit sensitivity, especially when dentin is exposed by decay, wear, gum recession, or injury.

Dentin Hypersensitivity

Alternate term; see *Dentin Sensitivity*.

Dentinogenesis

Formation of dentin by specialized cells during tooth development and repair. Abnormal dentin formation may produce weak, discolored, sensitive teeth that wear or fracture easily.

Dentinogenesis Imperfecta

An inherited disorder in which dentin forms abnormally, causing teeth that may look blue-gray or amber and break, wear, or discolor easily. Some forms occur with fragile bones.

Dentin Sensitivity

Brief, sharp tooth pain caused by cold, heat, sweet foods, touch, or air reaching exposed dentin. Decay, worn enamel, gum recession, cracks, or aggressive brushing can expose it.

Dentist

A licensed healthcare professional who examines, prevents, diagnoses, and treats diseases and injuries of the teeth, gums, jaw, and mouth.

Dentistry

The healthcare field concerned with preventing, diagnosing, and treating disorders and injuries of the teeth, gums, jaw, and mouth, including restoration, replacement, and oral health education.

Dentition

The teeth present in the mouth, including their number, arrangement, development, and eruption. Children usually have primary teeth that are replaced by permanent teeth; disease, injury, or development can alter either set.

Denture

A removable prosthetic appliance designed to replace missing teeth and their surrounding alveolar ridge and mucosal tissues, restoring mastication, speech articulation, lip and facial contour support, and dentofacial aesthetics. Categorized into complete dentures (indicated in edentulous dental arches, relying on mucosal seal and saliva adhesion) and removable partial dentures (RPDs, indicated in partially dentate arches, utilizing cast clasps or precision attachments anchored to remaining natural abutment teeth).

Denture Base

The part of a denture that rests on the gums and mouth tissues and supports the artificial teeth. Its shape and fit distribute chewing pressure and help prevent soreness.

Denture Problems

Difficulties caused by a removable denture, including poor fit, looseness, pain, sores, breakage, difficulty

chewing or speaking, or infection. A dental review may correct the cause or determine whether replacement is needed.

Dentures

Plural form; see *Denture*.

Denturist

A dental professional authorized in some regions to make, fit, adjust, and repair removable dentures within the local scope of practice. Dentists may also assess oral disease and provide related treatment.

Denver Developmental Screening Test

A screening questionnaire and task-based assessment for young children that checks personal-social, fine-motor, language, and gross-motor skills. It identifies possible developmental delay but does not diagnose its cause.

Denys-Drash Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder caused by changes in the *WT1* gene. It can cause severe kidney disease, differences in sex development, and a high risk of Wilms kidney tumor in childhood.

Deoxycoformycin

An anticancer medicine that blocks an enzyme needed by some cells to make DNA. It was used for selected blood cancers and can suppress bone marrow, weaken immunity, and increase the risk of serious infections.

Deoxycytidine

A DNA building block made of the base cytosine joined to the sugar deoxyribose. Cells use it to make and repair DNA.

Deoxycytidine Kinase

An enzyme that chemically activates deoxycytidine and some similar medicines. The activated medicines can interfere with the DNA of cancer cells or viruses and stop them from multiplying.

Deoxyglucose

A molecule resembling glucose that is used mainly in research and PET imaging. When labeled with a radioactive form of fluorine, it can show tissues using unusually large amounts of glucose, including many tumors and areas of inflammation.

Deoxyguanosine

A DNA building block made of the base guanine joined to the sugar deoxyribose. Cells use it to make and repair DNA.

Deoxyhemoglobin

Hemoglobin that is not carrying oxygen. A high amount in blood near the skin can make the lips, skin, or nail beds appear blue, a finding called cyanosis.

Deoxyribonuclease

An enzyme that breaks DNA into smaller pieces. An inhaled laboratory-made form can thin thick mucus in some people with cystic fibrosis by breaking down DNA released from damaged cells.

Deoxyribonucleic Acid

Full name; see *DNA*.

Deoxyribonucleosides

Molecules made of one of the four DNA bases joined to the sugar deoxyribose. Cells use them as starting materials when making or repairing DNA.

Deoxyribonucleotides

DNA building blocks made of a base, deoxyribose sugar, and phosphate groups. The four forms—dATP, dGTP, dCTP, and dTTP—are assembled into DNA strands.

Dependence

Physical adaptation to repeated exposure to a medicine or substance, so that reducing or stopping it can cause withdrawal symptoms. Dependence can occur with or without addiction.

Dependent Personality Disorder

A long-term pattern of excessive need to be cared for, difficulty making decisions independently, fear of separation, and submissive behavior that causes distress or impairs relationships and daily life.

Dependovirus

A group of small viruses that usually need another virus, such as an adenovirus or herpesvirus, to reproduce. They are generally not known to cause serious disease in healthy people.

Depersonalization

A feeling of being detached from or observing one's own body, thoughts, or emotions as if from outside. It can occur with anxiety, trauma, panic, substance use, or other mental health conditions.

Depersonalization-Derealization Disorder

A disorder causing repeated or persistent feelings that one's body, thoughts, emotions, or surroundings are unreal or distant, while the person knows these feelings are not literally true. Symptoms cause significant distress or impairment.

Depersonalization/Derealization Disorder

Alternate name; see *Depersonalization-Derealization Disorder*.

Dephosphorylation

Removal of a phosphate group from a molecule. This can switch proteins and other cell components on or off and change how cells communicate, use energy, grow, or respond to signals.

Depigmentation

Loss or reduction of normal pigment, especially melanin in the skin, hair, or mucous membranes. It may result from vitiligo, inflammation, injury, infection, chemical exposure, or treatment.

Depilation

Removal of hair at or near the skin surface by shaving, cutting, waxing, or a chemical product. It differs from epilation, which removes hair together with its root.

Depilatory Poisoning

Harmful exposure to a hair-removal product, usually by swallowing or contact with the eyes, skin, or airways. Ingredients may cause irritation, chemical burns, vomiting, or breathing problems.

Depolarization

A change that makes the inside of a cell less electrically negative. In nerve and muscle cells, it can start or transmit an electrical signal that produces movement or sensation.

Depolarizing Neuromuscular Blocker

A paralytic agent, exemplified exclusively by succinylcholine, that acts as an acetylcholine receptor agonist at the neuromuscular junction, inducing persistent membrane depolarization, transient muscle fasciculations, and subsequent flaccid motor paralysis.

Alternate Names:
Depolarizing Muscle Relaxant

Depot Implant

A small device placed in the body that releases medicine slowly over an extended period. It can provide steady treatment but may require a procedure for insertion and removal.

Deprescribing

A planned, supervised reduction or stopping of a medicine when its harms, burden, or limited benefit outweigh expected benefit. The plan considers withdrawal, return of illness, safer alternatives, and patient goals.

Depressed Fracture

A break in which bone is pushed inward, most often in the skull. It can injure the brain or other underlying tissue, especially with neurologic symptoms.

Depression

Persistent low mood, loss of interest or pleasure, or both; it may occur as a symptom or as part of

a depressive disorder. A major depressive episode involves at least five symptoms over the same two-week period, including low mood or loss of interest, and causes significant distress or impairment. Other symptoms may include changes in sleep, appetite, energy, concentration, movement, or self-worth.

Depression Screening

Use of questions or a validated questionnaire to identify possible depression. A positive screen is not a diagnosis; a clinician must assess symptoms, duration, impairment, medical causes, treatment needs, and safety.

Depressive Disorder

One of a group of mental disorders involving clinically significant depressive symptoms, such as low or irritable mood, reduced interest or pleasure, and changes in sleep, appetite, energy, or concentration. The symptom pattern and duration vary by diagnosis.

Depressive Illness

Broad, non-diagnostic term; see *Depressive Disorder*.

Depth Perception

The ability to judge how far away objects are and where they are in three-dimensional space. It depends mainly on using both eyes together and also on movement, size, shading, and perspective cues.

Depurination

Loss of the DNA bases adenine or guanine, leaving a gap in the DNA strand. If the gap is not repaired correctly, it can cause a genetic mutation.

De Quervain's Tendonitis

Alternate spelling; see *De Quervain Tenosynovitis*.

De Quervain's Tenosynovitis

Alternate spelling; see *De Quervain Tenosynovitis*.

De Quervain Tendinitis

Alternate name; see *De Quervain Tenosynovitis*.

De Quervain Tenosynovitis

Painful swelling and narrowing around the tendons on the thumb side of the wrist. It causes pain with thumb movement, gripping, or lifting and may cause tenderness or swelling near the base of the thumb.

Alternate Names:
Radial Styloid Tenosynovitis; De Quervain Tendinopathy

De Quervain Thyroiditis

A painful, temporary inflammation of the thyroid, often following a viral illness. It can cause neck tenderness and fever, with a temporary rise in thyroid hormone followed by a period of low levels before recovery.

Alternate Names:
Subacute Granulomatous Thyroiditis; Giant Cell Thyroiditis

Derbyshire Neck

Older term; see *Goiter*.

Dercum Disease (Adiposis Dolorosa)

Alternate names; see *Dercum's Disease*.

Dercum's Disease

A rare disorder characterized by multiple painful fatty growths, often with obesity, fatigue, and widespread tenderness. The cause is uncertain, and diagnosis is based on symptoms and examination after other causes are excluded.

Derealization

A feeling that the outside world is unreal, distant, dreamlike, or visually changed, while the person knows it is not literally unreal. It may occur with anxiety, panic, trauma, dissociation, or substance use.

Dermabrasion

A procedure that uses a rapidly rotating instrument to remove outer skin layers. It may improve selected scars, wrinkles, sun damage, or lesions but can cause pain, pigment changes, infection, or scarring.

Dermal

Relating to the dermis, the skin layer beneath the epidermis. The dermis contains connective tissue, blood vessels, nerves, hair follicles, and sweat glands that support and nourish the skin.

Dermal Fillers

Injectable materials placed under or within the skin to restore volume or reduce wrinkles or scars. Common effects include swelling and bruising; infection, lumps, skin damage, or rare blockage of a blood vessel can be serious.

Dermal Melanocytosis

A usually harmless blue-gray or slate-colored skin patch caused by pigment-producing cells located deep in the skin. It is often present at birth and commonly affects the lower back or buttocks.

Dermal Papilla

A small structure at the base of a hair follicle that supplies signals and nutrients to developing hair cells. Its activity helps control hair growth and the hair-growth cycle.

Dermal Structure

The dermis has a thin superficial layer and a deeper supportive layer. It contains collagen, elastic fibers, blood and lymph vessels, nerves, hair follicles, sweat glands, and oil glands.

Dermatan Sulfate

A long chain of sugar molecules found in skin, connective tissue, blood vessels, and heart valves. It helps organize tissues and can influence wound healing and blood clotting.

Dermatitis

Inflammation of the skin causing some combination of itching, redness, swelling, scaling, dryness, or blisters. It may result from irritation, allergy, infection, medicines, genetics, or another disease.

Dermatitis Herpetiformis

A chronic, intensely itchy autoimmune blistering rash associated with gluten-sensitive celiac disease. Groups of small bumps and blisters often occur symmetrically on the elbows, knees, buttocks, back, or scalp; scratching may leave erosions and crusts. The rash is linked to IgA antibody deposits in the skin.

Alternate Names:
Duhring-Brocq Disease

Dermatofibroma

A common harmless, firm skin nodule, often on the legs. It may be brown or pink and often dimples when pinched. It usually needs no treatment; changing or bleeding lesions can have other causes.

Dermatofibrosarcoma

A rare, slow-growing cancer of connective tissue in the skin. It usually begins as a firm plaque or nodule and can grow into nearby tissue, but it rarely spreads to distant organs.

Dermatofibrosarcoma Protuberans

A rare cancer arising from connective tissue in the skin. It often appears as a slowly enlarging firm plaque or nodule, commonly on the trunk; it can recur locally but rarely spreads. Complete surgical removal is the usual treatment.

Dermatofibrosarcoma Protuberans Of The Breast

A rare, usually slow-growing skin cancer involving the breast skin or nearby superficial tissue. It can extend into surrounding tissue and recur if incompletely removed; treatment aims for complete surgical removal.

Dermatoglyphics

The study of ridge patterns on the fingers, palms, toes, and soles. Patterns help with identification and may differ in some genetic or developmental conditions, but they cannot diagnose a condition by themselves.

Dermatographia

Alternate name; see *Dermatographism*.

Dermatographic Urticaria

Alternate name; see *Dermatographism*.

Dermatographism

Hives that appear as raised linear welts within minutes after the skin is stroked or scratched. They result from an exaggerated release of histamine and may occur with other allergic or hive disorders.

Dermatologic

Relating to the skin, hair, nails, or medical care for these structures. Dermatologic problems include rashes, infections, wounds, hair loss, nail changes, acne, and skin cancers.

Dermatologic Disorder

A disease affecting the skin, hair, nails, or skin glands. It may cause rash, scaling, pigment change, lumps, ulcers, pain, itching, hair loss, or abnormal nail growth.

Dermatologic Manifestations of Hematologic Disease

Skin, hair, nail, or mucosal findings caused by a blood or bone-marrow disorder, its treatment, or an associated infection. Examples include pallor, petechiae, purpura, bruising, pruritus, ulcers, nodules, and infiltrative lesions; new or unexplained findings may require blood tests and biopsy.

Dermatologist

A physician who specializes in diagnosing and treating disorders of the skin, hair, nails, and related mucous membranes, including infections, inflammatory diseases, tumors, and cosmetic concerns.

Dermatology

The medical specialty concerned with health and disease of the skin, hair, nails, and related mucous membranes. Dermatologists diagnose and manage inflammatory, infectious, immune-mediated, neoplastic, and other disorders, including skin signs of systemic disease; the specialty also includes medical and surgical skin care.

Dermatomal

Following or relating to a dermatome—a strip of skin supplied by sensory fibers from a single spinal nerve root. Dermatomal patterns can help localize nerve-root disease and are characteristic of some conditions, such as herpes zoster.

Dermatome

Either a surgical tool that removes a thin layer of skin for a graft or a strip of skin supplied by one spinal nerve. The meaning depends on whether the term is being used in surgery or nerve anatomy.

Dermatomycosis

A fungal infection of the skin, hair, or nails. It may cause scaling, itching, discoloration, cracking, or hair loss; treatment depends on the site and may require a topical or oral antifungal medicine.

Dermatomyositis

An autoimmune inflammatory myopathy affecting the skin and skeletal muscles. It often causes symmetric weakness of shoulder and hip muscles and a violaceous rash around the eyes or scaly papules over the knuckles. Skin disease can occur without obvious muscle weakness; adult-onset disease is associated with increased risk of some cancers.

Dermatopathology

The study of skin disease by examining tissue samples with a microscope and related laboratory methods. It helps distinguish inflammatory, infectious, harmless, and cancerous skin disorders.

Dermatophyte

A fungus that grows in keratin, the tough protein in skin, hair, and nails. It causes tinea infections such as athlete's foot, ringworm, and fungal nail disease.

Dermatophytosis

A superficial fungal infection of keratinized tissue, including the skin, hair, or nails, caused by dermatophytes. Also called tinea or ringworm, it includes infections of the body, scalp, groin, feet, and nails. Findings vary by site and may include scaly rashes, itching, cracked skin, or thickened, discolored nails.

Alternate Names:
Dermatophyte Infection; Dermatophyte Infections; Tinea

Dermatoplasty

Surgical repair or reconstruction of damaged skin, often using tissue rearrangement or a skin graft. It may restore coverage after injury, burns, removal of a lesion, or another operation.

Dermatoscope

A handheld optical instrument that magnifies and illuminates skin lesions, often with polarized or nonpolarized light. It reveals structures below the skin surface and supports clinical assessment of pigmented and other lesions.

Dermatosis

Any disease or disorder of the skin, including inflammatory, infectious, allergic, inherited, or tumor-related conditions. It may cause rash, itching, scaling, pigment changes, lumps, ulcers, or pain.

Dermis

The strong, flexible skin layer beneath the epidermis. It contains collagen and elastic fibers, blood vessels, nerves, hair follicles, and sweat and oil glands that support and nourish the skin.

Dermoid

A usually benign cyst or tumor containing tissues such as skin, hair, oil glands, fat, or teeth. It may occur in the ovary or other sites and can cause pressure, rupture, infection, or twisting of an organ.

Dermoid Cyst

A benign cyst or choristoma containing mature skin structures, such as hair follicles and oil or sweat glands. It is often developmental and may occur in the skin, around the eye, or elsewhere. An ovarian dermoid is a mature cystic teratoma; epidermoid cysts are a distinct type.

Dermoid Cyst Of The Ovary

A usually benign ovarian cyst that can contain skin, hair, fat, glands, or teeth. It may cause pain, pressure, rupture, or twisting of the ovary and is assessed with examination and imaging.

Dermoscopy

Examination of a skin lesion with magnification and special lighting that reveals structures not visible to the unaided eye. It helps assess pigmented and other lesions but does not replace biopsy when cancer is suspected.

Descemet Membrane Endothelial Keratoplasty

An advanced partial-thickness corneal transplantation procedure in which only the diseased recipient corneal endothelium and Descemet membrane are stripped and replaced by an isolated donor Descemet membrane-endothelium sheet. It offers rapid visual recovery and very low allograft rejection rates in corneal endothelial disorders such as Fuchs endothelial dystrophy.

Alternate Names:
DMEK

Descending Colon

The left-sided part of the large intestine, extending downward from the transverse colon toward the sigmoid colon. It absorbs water and salts and helps compact stool before it moves toward the rectum.

Descending Thoracic Aorta

The part of the body's main artery that runs from the aortic arch through the chest to the diaphragm. It gives branches to the chest wall and organs and continues as the abdominal aorta.

Desensitization

A treatment that gradually exposes a person to increasing or controlled amounts of a specific allergen or medicine. It can reduce immune reactions; serious reactions may occur during the process.

Desferrioxamine

A medicine that binds excess iron and helps remove it from the body. It is used for serious iron overload and selected aluminum toxicity; prolonged treat-

ment can affect hearing, vision, kidneys, or growth.

Desflurane

An inhaled medicine used to maintain general anesthesia. It acts quickly but may irritate the airway, lower blood pressure, cause nausea, or rarely trigger malignant hyperthermia in susceptible people.

Desiccate

To dry out or remove moisture from a tissue, substance, surface, or specimen. Excessive drying can damage skin or wounds and can alter medicines or laboratory samples.

Desiccated Thyroid

A thyroid-hormone medicine made from dried animal thyroid tissue. It contains mainly thyroxine and triiodothyronine; excess treatment can cause palpitations, bone loss, or other effects, so blood tests and monitoring are needed.

Alternate Names:
Desiccated Thyroid Extract; Natural Desiccated Thyroid

Desipramine

A tricyclic antidepressant that increases norepinephrine activity. It is used for selected mental health or pain conditions but may cause dry mouth, constipation, drowsiness, abnormal heart rhythms, or dangerous overdose.

Desipramine Hydrochloride Overdose

Taking too much desipramine hydrochloride can cause severe drowsiness, confusion, seizures, low blood pressure, coma, and life-threatening heart-rhythm or conduction problems. It requires emergency assessment, even if symptoms are initially mild.

Desmin

A structural protein that links parts of muscle cells and helps maintain their alignment. Changes in the desmin gene or abnormal desmin buildup can cause muscle weakness and heart-muscle disease.

Desmoid Tumor

A locally aggressive growth of fibrous tissue that usually does not spread to distant organs but can invade nearby structures and recur. It may be associated with familial adenomatous polyposis; treatment depends on location and symptoms.

Desmoid Tumors

Plural form; see *Desmoid Tumor*.

Desmoid Tumour

Alternate spelling; see *Desmoid Tumor*.

Desmoplasia

A dense, scar-like tissue response rich in collagen and fibroblast-like cells. It commonly forms around invasive cancers, especially carcinomas, and can also occur with some benign tumors or tissue injury. It may make an area firm but does not by itself show whether a tumor is benign or malignant.

Desmoplastic

Describing the formation of dense, scar-like fibrous tissue, often around a tumor or in response to chronic inflammation or injury.

Desmoplastic Fibroblastoma

A rare, usually harmless tumor made of collagen-producing cells. It is typically a slow-growing, painless lump in superficial or deep soft tissue and is treated according to its size, site, and symptoms.

Desmoplastic Fibroma

A rare noncancerous but locally aggressive fibrous growth in bone. It can cause pain, swelling, or fracture and may return after treatment.

Desmoplastic Infantile Ganglioglioma

A rare, usually slow-growing brain tumor of infancy containing both nerve-cell and support-cell components. It may cause seizures, increasing head size, vomiting, or other signs of pressure in the brain.

Desmoplastic Melanoma

A rare form of skin melanoma with abundant scar-

like tissue. It often develops on sun-damaged skin, may have little or no pigment, and can grow deeply or recur locally.

Desmoplastic Reaction

Formation of dense, scar-like fibrous tissue in response to injury, chronic inflammation, or invasion by a cancer. It may make affected tissue firm and can complicate interpretation of imaging or biopsy.

Desmoplastic Small Round Cell Tumor

A rare and aggressive soft-tissue sarcoma that usually develops in the abdomen or pelvis of children, adolescents, or young adults, especially males. It often forms several masses on the lining of the abdomen and can spread within the abdomen or to other sites. Symptoms may include abdominal swelling or pain, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, or constipation. Tumor cells typically have an *EWSR1-WT1* gene fusion, which helps confirm the diagnosis.

Desmoplastic Small Round Cell Tumors

Plural form; see *Desmoplastic Small Round Cell Tumor*.

Desmoplastic Trichoepithelioma

A rare harmless tumor arising from a hair follicle, usually appearing as a small firm facial bump or ring-shaped lesion. It can resemble a skin cancer and may require biopsy for confirmation.

Desmopressin

A medicine that mimics vasopressin, a hormone that reduces urine production and helps control bleeding. It is used for central diabetes insipidus, some bleeding disorders, and selected nighttime urination problems; excess fluid can dangerously lower blood sodium.

Desmosome

A strong junction that fastens neighboring cells together, especially in the skin and heart muscle. It links internal support fibers and helps tissues resist stretching and friction.

Desogestrel

A progestin used in some hormonal contraceptives. It prevents pregnancy mainly by suppressing ovulation and thickening cervical mucus; irregular bleeding, mood changes, breast tenderness, or other hormonal effects may occur.

Desonide

A low-strength corticosteroid applied to the skin to reduce redness, itching, and inflammation from conditions such as eczema or dermatitis. Excessive or prolonged use can thin the skin or cause other local effects.

Desoximetasone

A corticosteroid applied to the skin to reduce inflammation and itching in responsive rashes. Strength, body site, amount, and duration affect the risk of skin thinning and absorption into the body.

Desoxycorticosterone

A steroid hormone with mineralocorticoid effects. It makes the kidneys retain sodium and water and lose potassium, thereby influencing blood volume and blood pressure.

Desquamation

Shedding or peeling of the outer layer of skin or another body lining. It may be normal or result from dryness, irritation, infection, inflammation, burns, medicines, or another skin disorder.

Desquamative Interstitial Pneumonia

A rare inflammatory lung disease strongly associated with smoking. Immune cells collect in the air sacs, causing cough and breathlessness; treatment may include smoking cessation and anti-inflammatory medicines.

Desquamative Inflammatory Vaginitis

Long-lasting inflammation of the vagina that can cause irritation, pain, and discharge. Its cause is not fully known; it can overlap with severe aerobic vaginitis but is not usually linked to a common vaginal infection.

Desulfovibrio

A group of bacteria that can live without oxygen and use sulfate during metabolism. They occur in the environment and intestine; invasive human infection is uncommon and must fit the patient's symptoms and specimen findings.

Desvenlafaxine Succinate

A form of desvenlafaxine, an antidepressant that increases serotonin and norepinephrine signaling. It is used for major depressive disorder and may cause nausea, insomnia, increased blood pressure, or withdrawal symptoms if stopped suddenly.

Desynchronosis

Alternate name; see *Jet Lag*.

Detached

Describes tissue separated from its normal attachment or position, as when the retina lifts from the back of the eye or the placenta separates from the uterine wall before birth. The specific structure and type of separation are named in the full term.

Detached Retina

Separation of the light-sensitive retina from the tissue beneath it. Flashes, new floaters, or a curtain-like shadow may occur; it is an emergency because delayed treatment can cause permanent vision loss.

Detergent

A cleaning substance that helps remove oils and dirt from surfaces. Some detergents can irritate or burn the skin, eyes, airways, or digestive tract, especially when concentrated or swallowed.

Deterministic Effects

Tissue injuries from radiation that usually occur only after exposure exceeds a threshold. Higher exposure generally causes more severe injury, such as skin damage, cataracts, or tissue death.

Detoxification

Medical treatment that reduces the effects of a poison or helps the body remove it. Care may include supportive treatment, an antidote, activated charcoal, or dialysis; stomach washing is rarely appropriate.

Detritic Synovitis

Inflammation of the lining of a joint caused by loose particles from damaged cartilage, bone, blood, crystals, or a worn implant. It can cause swelling, pain, stiffness, and reduced movement.

Detrusor Instability

Involuntary contractions of the bladder muscle while the bladder is filling. They can cause sudden urinary urgency, frequent urination, nighttime urination, or urge leakage.

Detrusor Muscle

The muscle forming the bladder wall. It relaxes while urine collects and contracts to empty the bladder; abnormal activity can cause urgency or leakage, while weak activity can make emptying difficult.

Detrusor Sphincter Dyssynergia

A neurological voiding disorder occurring in patients with suprasacral spinal cord lesions, characterized by involuntary, simultaneous contraction of the urinary bladder detrusor muscle and the external urethral sphincter during micturition, producing functional bladder outlet obstruction.

Alternate Names:
DSD

Detumescence

Return of erectile tissue to its non-erect state after sexual stimulation or an erection ends. It occurs when blood leaves the erectile tissue and pressure falls.

Deubiquitinating Enzymes

Enzymes that remove a small regulatory tag from other proteins. This can change whether a protein is broken down, where it works, and how cells control signals, repair DNA, and respond to infection.

Deubiquitination

Removal of the ubiquitin tag from a protein. This process can prevent the protein from being broken down or can change its activity, location, or role in cell signaling.

Deuteranopia

An inherited red-green color-vision deficiency caused by missing green-sensitive pigment in the retina. People may have difficulty distinguishing some shades of green, red, brown, and orange.

Deuterium

A naturally occurring form of hydrogen whose nucleus contains one proton and one neutron. Small amounts occur in water; very high exposure to heavy water can disrupt cell function.

Development

The progressive growth and change by which a person, organ, or ability acquires its structure and function. It includes physical, brain, language, emotional, social, and adaptive changes.

Developmental Coordination Disorder

A childhood condition in which movement skills develop more slowly or less accurately than expected and interfere with dressing, writing, sports, school, or daily activities. It is not explained only by another medical or neurologic condition.

Developmental Delay

A child's acquisition of movement, language, thinking, social, or self-care skills is slower than expected for age. Delay may affect one or several areas and can result from genetic, neurologic, sensory, medical, or environmental causes.

Developmental Disabilities

Lifelong conditions that begin during childhood and affect movement, learning, thinking, language, behavior, or ability to manage daily activities. Support needs vary and may include medical, educational, communication, and social services.

Developmental Disorder

A broad, heterogeneous group of neurodevelopmental conditions originating during early embryonic, fetal, or childhood development that cause chronic impairment across motor, cognitive, communicative, learning, behavioral, or adaptive domains. Typically exhibits an early childhood onset and lifelong course, including autism spectrum disorder, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), intellectual disability, specific learning disorders, and cerebral palsy, arising from complex multifactorial interactions between genetic susceptibility and environmental perinatal insults.

Developmental Disorders

Plural form; see *Developmental Disorder*.

Developmental Dysplasia Of The Hip

A developmental abnormality of the hip joint in which the femoral head is unstable within or improperly aligned with the acetabulum. The spectrum ranges from a shallow socket to subluxation or dislocation. It is usually present at birth but may become apparent during infancy.

Developmental Expressive Language Disorder

A childhood disorder causing persistent difficulty expressing ideas with spoken words, sentences, or grammar. Hearing differences, developmental conditions, autism, and other factors can contribute to or resemble it.

Developmental Genital Tract Anomalies

Differences in the formation or structure of the uterus, cervix, vagina, fallopian tubes, or external genitalia that arise before birth. Effects range from none to infertility, pain, menstrual problems, or pregnancy complications.

Developmental History

A record of a child's developmental milestones and abilities, including motor, language, cognitive, social, and adaptive skills, used to identify possible delays or regression.

Developmental Milestone

Alternate name; see *Developmental Milestones*.

Developmental Milestones

Skills that most children learn as they grow, such as sitting, walking, talking, and interacting with others. The timing varies from child to child. Health professionals use milestones to follow development and identify children who may need further assessment.

Alternate Names:
Child Development Milestones; Pediatric Milestones

Developmental Milestones Record

Alternate name; see *Developmental Milestones*.

Developmental Process

The physical, brain, emotional, social, and functional changes through which a person or organ grows and acquires abilities. Development is influenced by genes, health, nutrition, relationships, learning, and environment.

Developmental Psychology

The study of how thinking, emotions, relationships, behavior, and abilities change from infancy through old age. It examines the effects of genes, health, learning, experience, relationships, and environment.

Developmental Reading Disorder

A learning disorder causing persistent difficulty learning accurate, fluent reading. Problems may include recognizing words, linking letters to sounds, spelling, or understanding written language despite appropriate teaching.

Developmental Regression

Loss of skills a child previously acquired, such as speech, movement, social interaction, or self-care. Regression is a warning sign requiring prompt evaluation for neurologic, genetic, metabolic, infectious, or other causes.

Developmental Stage

A period of growth characterized by typical physical, thinking, emotional, social, language, or self-care changes. Children vary, so stages describe broad patterns rather than exact deadlines.

Developmental Surveillance

Ongoing monitoring of a child's development through caregiver concerns, observation, history, and milestone review during routine care. It can identify concerns early but differs from formal screening with a standardized tool.

Deviated Nasal Septum

Alternate name for deviated septum, in which the wall dividing the nasal passages is displaced from the midline.

Alternate Names:
Deviated Septum; Nasal Septal Deviation

Deviated Septum

A nasal partition displaced away from the center, often from normal development or injury. A marked deviation can block one side, causing difficulty breathing through the nose, congestion, nosebleeds, sinus problems, or sleep symptoms.

Deviation

A departure from an expected position, direction, value, or pattern, such as a bone shifted from its normal alignment or a laboratory result outside its reference range. The term describes a finding; it does not identify its cause.

Devic Disease

An older name associated with neuromyelitis optica spectrum disorder (NMOSD), an antibody-mediated inflammatory disorder of the central nervous system. NMOSD can affect the optic nerves, spinal cord, area postrema, brainstem, or other regions; the classic presentation combines optic neuritis and longitudinally extensive transverse myelitis. AQP4-IgG is common but not present in every case.

Alternate Names:
Neuromyelitis Optica; NMO

Device Embolisation

Movement of a medical device or broken piece of one through the bloodstream until it lodges in and blocks a blood vessel. It can reduce blood flow and may cause pain, organ injury, or an emergency requiring removal.

Devices For Hearing Loss

Equipment that improves access to sound, including hearing aids, cochlear implants, bone-conduction devices, alerting systems, and communication accessories. Choice depends on the type and severity of hearing loss and personal needs.

De Winter ECG Pattern

Alternate name; see *De Winter T-Wave Pattern*.

De Winter T-Wave Pattern

An electrocardiographic pattern associated with acute occlusion of the left anterior descending coronary artery, even without typical ST-segment elevation. It features upsloping ST depression at the J points across the anterior chest leads, followed by tall, symmetric T waves; slight ST elevation may appear in lead aVR. It is a high-risk acute coronary occlusion pattern.

Alternate Names:
De Winter ECG Sign; De Winter ECG Pattern; De Winter Pattern; De Winter Sign; De Winter T Waves

DEXA Scan

Dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry; a low-dose radiological test measuring bone mineral density to diagnose osteopenia and osteoporosis. See *Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry*.

Dexamethasone

A strong, long-acting corticosteroid that reduces inflammation and immune activity. It is used for selected allergic, brain-swelling, cancer-related, endocrine, and other conditions; risks include infection, high blood sugar, mood changes, and adrenal suppression.

Dexamethasone Suppression Test

A test that checks whether dexamethasone lowers cortisol production. Cortisol is measured after a dose of dexamethasone; failure to suppress can suggest Cushing syndrome. Oral estrogen, acute illness, major depression, alcohol use disorder, and medicines that alter dexamethasone breakdown can affect the result.

Dexamphetamine

Alternate name; see *Dextroamphetamine*.

Dexibuprofen

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for short-term pain and inflammation. It can irritate the stomach and may cause ulcers, bleeding, kidney injury, fluid retention, or cardiovascular problems.

Dexketoprofen

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for short-term pain. It reduces substances that cause pain and inflammation but can cause stomach bleeding, kidney injury, fluid retention, heart problems, or allergic reactions.

Dexlansoprazole

A proton-pump inhibitor that reduces stomach-acid production. It is used for acid reflux and related esophageal injury; prolonged use may contribute to infections, low magnesium or vitamin B12, fractures, or kidney inflammation.

Dexmedetomidine

A sedative that activates alpha-2 receptors and is given by injection during monitored care or intensive care. It usually depresses breathing less than many sedatives but can slow the heart or lower blood pressure.

Dexmethylphenidate

A stimulant used to treat attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder. It increases dopamine and norepinephrine activity and may cause reduced appetite, insomnia, headache, increased heart rate or blood pressure, or misuse.

Dexrazoxane

A medicine used in selected cancer treatments to reduce heart damage from anthracyclines or tissue injury after leakage of an anthracycline from a vein. It can suppress bone marrow and increase infection risk.

Dexrazoxane Hydrochloride

A salt form of dexrazoxane used in selected settings to reduce anthracycline-related heart damage or tissue injury after medicine leakage from a vein. Its use requires specialist dosing and monitoring.

Dextrin

A group of shorter carbohydrate chains formed when starch breaks down. Dextrins are used in foods, laboratory products, and medicines and are generally digested as carbohydrates.

Dextroamphetamine

A stimulant medicine used for attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder and narcolepsy. It can reduce appetite, disturb sleep, raise heart rate or blood pressure, and cause dependence.

Dextrocardia

A congenital condition in which the heart points or lies mainly on the right side of the chest. It may occur alone or with reversed organs and structural heart defects.

Dextromethorphan

A cough suppressant that reduces activity in brain pathways controlling the cough reflex. Excessive amounts can cause drowsiness, agitation, hallucinations, seizures, breathing depression, or serotonin toxicity.

Dextromethorphan Overdose

Taking too much dextromethorphan can cause drowsiness, confusion, agitation, hallucinations, fast heartbeat, seizures, breathing depression, or serotonin toxicity.

Dextroposition Of The Heart

The heart is pushed toward the right side of the chest by nearby organs, the diaphragm, lung disease, or another space-occupying problem. The heart itself may be normally formed and is not necessarily reversed as in dextrocardia.

Dextrose

D-glucose, a simple sugar used for energy. Oral or intravenous dextrose can treat or prevent low blood glucose, but excessive amounts can raise blood sugar and disturb body fluids.

DFSP

Alternate name; see *Dermatofibrosarcoma Protuberans*.

DH

Abbreviation commonly used for dermatitis herpetiformis, an intensely itchy blistering skin disorder associated with gluten-sensitive enteropathy and celiac disease. The abbreviation can have other meanings depending on context.

DHA

Docosahexaenoic acid, an omega-3 fatty acid that is an important part of brain and retinal cell membranes. It is obtained mainly from oily fish, some algae, and supplements.

DHEA

Dehydroepiandrosterone, a hormone precursor made mainly by the adrenal glands. The body can convert it into male and female sex hormones; levels vary with age, illness, and some hormone disorders.

DHEA-Sulfate Test

A blood test measuring a hormone made mainly by the adrenal glands. It can help investigate early puberty, excess body hair, some hormone disorders, congenital adrenal hyperplasia, or an adrenal tumor; results vary with age and sex.

Diabetes And Alcohol

Alcohol can cause delayed low blood glucose, inter-

act with medicines, and make glucose control harder. Risk depends on amount, timing, food intake, diabetes type, liver health, and treatment.

Diabetes And Exercise

Physical activity can improve glucose control, fitness, and heart health. People using insulin or medicines that lower glucose may need to check levels and adjust food or treatment with professional guidance to prevent low glucose.

Diabetes And Eye Disease

Diabetes can damage retinal blood vessels, causing retinopathy and macular swelling that may reduce vision. Good glucose and blood-pressure control and regular dilated eye examinations help prevent or limit sight loss.

Diabetes And Eye Problems

Diabetes may cause retinopathy, macular swelling, cataracts, glaucoma, and vision loss. Glucose and blood-pressure control, regular dilated eye examinations, and timely laser, injection, or surgical treatment reduce the risk of severe loss.

Diabetes And Kidney Disease

Kidney damage caused by diabetes. It may begin with albumin leaking into urine and progress to reduced kidney function or kidney failure; glucose, blood-pressure, and kidney monitoring can slow progression.

Diabetes And Metabolic Health

Diabetes is linked with insulin resistance, excess body fat, abnormal cholesterol, and high blood pressure. Together these problems increase the risk of heart disease and can worsen blood-glucose control.

Diabetes And Nerve Damage

Long-term diabetes can injure nerves, causing burning pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, digestive or bladder problems, sexual difficulties, or loss of protective feeling in the feet.

Diabetes Complications

Problems caused by diabetes, including low or high glucose emergencies and long-term damage to the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, blood vessels, teeth, and feet. Regular monitoring and risk-factor control reduce risk.

Diabetes Eye Exams

Eye examinations that look for diabetic retinopathy, macular swelling, cataracts, glaucoma, and other sight-threatening problems. Dilated examination or retinal photography may detect changes before vision is affected.

Diabetes in Children: Dealing with Low Blood Sugar

Recognition and treatment of hypoglycemia in a child with diabetes. Symptoms may include sweating, trembling, hunger, irritability, confusion, seizure, or loss of consciousness; fast-acting glucose is used when the child is awake and able to swallow, with emergency glucagon for severe episodes.

Diabetes in Children: Preventing Low Blood Sugar

Measures to reduce hypoglycemia in children with diabetes, including individualized insulin dosing, regular meals and snacks, glucose monitoring, planning around activity, and education about symptoms and emergency glucagon.

Diabetes in Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Diabetes Mellitus and Pregnancy*.

Diabetes in Pregnancy (Gestational Diabetes)

Alternate name; see *Gestational Diabetes*.

Diabetes Insipidus

A rare disorder of water balance that causes the body to produce unusually large amounts of dilute, watery urine and triggers constant, intense thirst. It occurs either when the brain fails to produce enough antidiuretic hormone (vasopressin)—which tells the kidneys to retain water—or when the kidneys fail

to respond to this hormone. Despite sharing part of its name with diabetes mellitus, it does not involve insulin or high blood sugar levels.

Diabetes Medications

Medicines that lower blood glucose or replace insulin. They work in different ways, and the choice depends on the type of diabetes, kidney and heart health, other medicines, cost, and treatment goals.

Diabetes Mellitus

A chronic metabolic condition characterized by persistently high levels of sugar (glucose) in the bloodstream, resulting from problems with the hormone insulin. In extbftype 1 diabetes, the immune system mistakenly destroys the insulin-producing cells of the pancreas, causing an absolute lack of insulin. In extbftype 2 diabetes, the body's cells become resistant to insulin, and the pancreas eventually cannot produce enough to keep up. Over time, high blood sugar damages blood vessels and nerves throughout the body, raising the risk of heart disease, kidney damage, vision loss, and foot complications.

Alternate Names:
Diabetes

Diabetes Mellitus and Pregnancy

Diabetes before or first recognized during pregnancy can increase risks of miscarriage, fetal overgrowth or growth restriction, congenital anomalies, hypertensive disease, stillbirth, and neonatal metabolic problems. Glucose control, retinal and kidney assessment, medication review, and fetal surveillance are important.

Diabetes Mellitus Type 1

An autoimmune disorder in which the immune system destroys insulin-producing pancreatic cells, causing little or no insulin. It can begin at any age and requires insulin; untreated deficiency can cause ketoacidosis.

Diabetes Mellitus Type 2

A disorder in which the body resists insulin and, over time, may not make enough of it. Risk is increased by family history, excess body weight, and inactivity; it can occur at any age and may have no early symptoms.

Diabetes Prevention

The risk of type 2 diabetes can often be reduced through regular physical activity, nutritious meals, avoiding tobacco, adequate sleep, and weight loss when appropriate. People at increased risk may benefit from structured prevention programs and regular testing.

Diabetes-Related Foot Disease

Infection, ulceration, or tissue destruction of the foot in a person with current or previous diabetes, usually associated with peripheral neuropathy or peripheral artery disease. Neuropathy, poor blood flow, deformity, and pressure can contribute to tissue injury and impaired healing.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Foot Disease

Diabetes Treatment

Diabetes treatment combines nutrition, physical activity, glucose monitoring, education, and medicines chosen for the type of diabetes and individual risks. Care also addresses blood pressure, lipids, kidneys, eyes, nerves, feet, vaccines, and cardiovascular health.

Diabetic Amyotrophy

A painful diabetic lumbosacral radiculoplexus neuropathy, usually beginning with sudden pain in one hip or thigh followed by proximal leg weakness and muscle wasting. It can spread to the other leg and is distinct from the more common distal symmetric diabetic polyneuropathy.

Diabetic Angiopathy

Damage to small or large blood vessels caused by diabetes. It can reduce circulation, injure the eyes, kidneys, heart, brain, or feet, and increase the risk of wounds, heart attack, or stroke.

Diabetic Autonomic Neuropathy

Diabetes-related damage to nerves that control automatic body functions. It may cause dizziness

on standing, fast heartbeat, sweating changes, delayed stomach emptying, bladder problems, sexual dysfunction, or reduced awareness of low glucose.

Diabetic Cardiomyopathies

Heart-muscle disease associated with diabetes that is not fully explained by blocked heart arteries or high blood pressure. It can make the heart relax or pump poorly and may lead to heart failure.

Diabetic Cardiomyopathy

Heart-muscle damage associated with diabetes, after other causes such as blocked arteries and high blood pressure are considered. It may cause poor relaxation, weak pumping, heart failure, or rhythm problems.

Diabetic Coma

Profound unconsciousness caused by a severe diabetes-related problem, such as extremely low or high blood glucose, ketoacidosis, severe dehydration, or abnormal body chemistry. It is a medical emergency.

Diabetic Complications

Alternate name; see *Diabetes Complications*.

Diabetic Diet

An individualized eating pattern for diabetes that balances carbohydrate portions, fiber, protein, and healthy fats with medicines, activity, culture, and health goals. It supports glucose control without requiring the same foods or schedule for everyone.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Meal Plan; Medical Nutrition Therapy for Diabetes

Diabetic Eye Disease

Eye damage caused by diabetes, including diabetic retinopathy, diabetic macular edema, cataract, glaucoma, and cranial-nerve or optic-nerve complications. Regular dilated eye examinations can detect treatable disease before vision is lost.

Diabetic Focal Neuropathy

Alternate name; see *Diabetic Neuropathy*.

Diabetic Foot

Alternate name; see *Diabetes-Related Foot Disease*.

Diabetic Foot Infections

Infection involving the skin, soft tissue, or bone of a diabetic foot. Neuropathy, ischemia, ulceration, and impaired immunity can conceal severity or delay healing, so assessment includes depth, perfusion, systemic illness, and need for antimicrobial therapy or source control.

Diabetic Foot Ulcer

A chronic non-healing sore on the foot in a person with diabetes, usually caused by a combination of peripheral neuropathy, poor blood circulation, and localized pressure or minor trauma.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Ulcer; Neuropathic Foot Ulcer; Diabetic Foot Sore

Diabetic Gastroparesis

A complication of diabetes in which damage to the stomach's nerves slows the movement of food from the stomach into the small intestine. It may cause early fullness, nausea, vomiting, bloating, abdominal pain, and difficult-to-control blood sugar levels.

Diabetic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State*.

Diabetic Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State

Alternate name; see *Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State*.

Diabetic Hypoglycemia

Blood glucose that is too low in a person with diabetes, often because of insulin, certain medicines, missed food, alcohol, or unusual exercise. Shaking, sweating, confusion, seizures, or unconsciousness

may occur.

Diabetic Ketoacidosis

A life-threatening complication of diabetes—most commonly type 1 diabetes—that occurs when the body lacks sufficient insulin to move sugar from the blood into cells for energy. In response, the body rapidly breaks down fat for fuel, generating high levels of toxic blood acids called ketones. This causes the blood to become dangerously acidic while blood sugar climbs to high levels. Symptoms include extreme thirst, frequent urination, nausea and vomiting, rapid deep breathing, abdominal pain, a fruity breath odor, and severe dehydration or confusion.

Alternate Names:
DKA

Diabetic Ketoacidosis Monitoring

Monitoring during treatment includes frequent glucose checks, blood salts, kidney function, ketones, acidity, fluid balance, urine output, and mental status. Close monitoring helps guide fluids, insulin, and electrolyte replacement safely.

Diabetic Kidney Disease

Kidney disease occurring in a person with diabetes, often attributed to diabetes when no other cause is evident. It may involve albumin in the urine, reduced kidney filtering, or both, and can progress to kidney failure. Other causes of chronic kidney disease should also be considered.

Diabetic Macular Edema

Swelling of the macula caused by fluid leaking from retinal blood vessels damaged by diabetes. It may occur at any stage of diabetic retinopathy and can blur or distort central vision.

Diabetic Mastopathy

A benign fibroinflammatory breast lesion associated mainly with long-standing type 1 diabetes, but also reported with type 2 diabetes and autoimmune disease. It usually presents as a firm, often painless mass that can mimic breast cancer on examination and imaging; tissue examination shows fibrosis with lymphocytic inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Fibrous Mastopathy

Diabetic Microvascular Complications

Diabetes-related damage to small blood vessels, mainly affecting the eyes, kidneys, and nerves. Good glucose, blood-pressure, and cholesterol control, along with regular screening, lowers the risk of progression.

Diabetic Nephropathy

Alternate name; see *Diabetic Kidney Disease*.

Diabetic Neuropathy

Nerve damage associated with diabetes, including distal symmetric polyneuropathy, autonomic neuropathy, and focal or radiculoplexus neuropathies. Symptoms vary with the nerves affected and may include pain, numbness, weakness, loss of protective sensation, or impaired autonomic function.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Nerve Damage

Diabetic Peripheral Neuropathy

Diabetes-related damage to nerves, usually beginning in the toes and feet and later affecting the hands. It can cause numbness, burning pain, weakness, and loss of protective sensation that increases injury risk.

Diabetic Proximal Neuropathy

Alternate name; see *Diabetic Amyotrophy*.

Diabetic Retinopathy

Damage to retinal blood vessels caused by diabetes. It ranges from nonproliferative changes, such as microaneurysms and hemorrhages, to proliferative disease with abnormal new blood vessels. Leakage can cause macular edema, while bleeding or scar tissue can lead to vision loss or tractional retinal detachment. Early disease may have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Microangiopathy of Retina

Diabetic Third Nerve Palsy

An oculomotor nerve palsy associated with diabetes, usually attributed to microvascular ischemia after other causes are considered. It may cause double vision, eyelid drooping, and impaired eye movement; the pupil is often spared but can be involved, so pupil status alone does not establish the cause.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Oculomotor Neuropathy; Diabetic Cranial Neuropathy III

Diabetogenic

Able to cause or promote diabetes or high blood glucose. The term may describe a disease, hormone, medicine, genetic change, or other factor that reduces insulin action or increases glucose production.

Diabetologist

A physician specializing in diabetes prevention, diagnosis, and treatment, including glucose management and complications involving the heart, kidneys, nerves, eyes, and feet.

Diabrosis

An old medical term for erosion or corrosion that eats through tissue and may cause an ulcer or perforation, especially in a blood-vessel or organ wall. Modern reports usually name the specific cause and injury.

Diacetoxyscirpenol

A toxin produced by some Fusarium molds that can contaminate food or animal feed. Exposure may irritate the digestive tract, suppress blood-cell production, and impair immune function.

Diacylglycerol

A fat-like molecule made from cell membranes that acts as an internal chemical signal. It helps control cell growth, movement, secretion, metabolism, and responses to hormones or other signals.

Diagnosis

Identification of a disease or health condition using symptoms, medical history, examination, and appropriate tests. A clinician may compare several possible causes before reaching the most likely diagnosis.

Diagnostic

Pertaining to, assisting in, or serving as the basis for a clinical diagnosis—the precise identification and characterization of a disease, disorder, or injury from its signs, symptoms, history, examination, imaging, and laboratory findings.

Diagnostic Imaging

Use of images to detect, locate, or monitor disease or injury. Methods include X-ray, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and nuclear imaging; findings vary with the clinical situation.

Diagnostic Laparoscopy

A minimally invasive procedure in which a camera is inserted through small abdominal incisions to inspect pelvic or abdominal organs. The clinician may take tissue samples or perform treatment during the same procedure.

Diagnostic Microbiology

Laboratory testing used to identify microorganisms that may cause disease. Methods include microscopy, culture, antigen or antibody tests, and genetic tests; results depend on symptoms and the specimen site.

Diagnostic Peritoneal Lavage

An older emergency test for serious internal bleeding or injury after major abdominal trauma. A small tube is placed into the abdomen and fluid is put in and then removed for testing. Ultrasound and CT scans are now used more often, but this test may still be used when those scans are not available.

Alternate Names:
DPL; Peritoneal Lavage; Abdominal Lavage

Diagnostic Procedure

An examination or procedure used to identify, exclude, locate, or monitor a disease or injury. The purpose, preparation, risks, accuracy, and follow-up

depend on the specific procedure and patient.

Diagnostic Radiology

The medical specialty that uses imaging to diagnose and characterize disease or injury. It includes X-ray, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and selected nuclear-medicine studies.

Diagnostics

Plural form; see *Diagnostic*.

Diagnostic Service

A healthcare service that collects or interprets information to detect, identify, characterize, or monitor a disease or health condition, such as laboratory testing, imaging, or specialist assessment.

Diagnostic Test

A test used to evaluate symptoms, signs, or an abnormal screening result and help confirm, exclude, or characterize a disease. Its value depends on accuracy, timing, the patient's condition, and how the result will guide care.

Diagnostic Trial

A clinical study that evaluates how accurately a test detects, rules out, or predicts a disease or important health outcome. Researchers may compare it with an established test or another accepted way of determining the diagnosis.

Diagnostic Uncertainty

A state in which the available symptoms, examination findings, and test results do not establish one diagnosis with sufficient confidence. It may occur when different diseases cause similar symptoms or when evidence is incomplete or inconclusive.

Diakinesis

The final stage before the first division that produces eggs or sperm. Paired chromosomes become tightly packed and remain connected at points where they exchanged genetic material.

Dialectical Behavior Therapy

A structured talking treatment that combines behavior-change skills with mindfulness and acceptance. It teaches ways to manage intense emotions, tolerate distress, improve relationships, and reduce harmful behaviors.

Dialister Pneumosintes

A bacterium found in the mouth and respiratory tract that grows without oxygen. It may contribute to mixed infections; significance of a positive sample depends on symptoms and collection site.

Dialysis

Treatment that replaces part of the kidneys' work by removing waste, excess water, and some chemicals from the blood. The main types are hemodialysis and peritoneal dialysis.

Dialysis Access

A route used to connect a person's blood circulation to a hemodialysis machine. Options include an arteriovenous fistula, graft, or central venous catheter; each has different risks of infection, clotting, and inadequate flow.

Dialysis Adequacy

How well dialysis removes waste and extra fluid and keeps body salts and acid levels within a safe range. Blood tests, treatment records, symptoms, nutrition, and weight help determine whether dialysis is sufficient.

Dialysis Complications of Chronic Renal Failure

Acute and chronic problems related to hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis, including hypotension, disequilibrium, access infection or thrombosis, bleeding, electrolyte shifts, peritonitis, and amyloidosis.

Dialysis Disequilibrium Syndrome

A rare brain reaction during or soon after starting or intensifying hemodialysis, caused by rapid changes in dissolved substances. Headache, nausea, confusion, seizures, or coma may occur; gradual treatment reduces risk.

Dialysis Machine

Equipment that moves blood or dialysis fluid across a filter to remove waste, excess water, and selected salts when the kidneys cannot do so adequately.

Dialysis-Related Beta-2m Amyloidosis

Amyloid deposition caused by accumulation of beta-2 microglobulin in people receiving long-term dialysis, especially with inadequate clearance. It can cause shoulder or joint pain, carpal tunnel syndrome, bone cysts, and destructive arthropathy.

Dialysis Solutions

Specially prepared fluids used during hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis. They allow waste and excess water to move out of the blood; their salt, glucose, and other contents are adjusted to the patient's needs.

Dialysis Therapy

Use of hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis to replace part of kidney function by removing waste and excess fluid and correcting some salt and acid imbalances. Treatment is individualized according to kidney function, symptoms, health, and goals.

Diamine

A molecule containing two amino groups. Diamines occur naturally in metabolism and are used in laboratory, pharmaceutical, and industrial chemistry; health effects depend on the specific compound and exposure.

Diamond-Blackfan Anemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the bone marrow makes too few red blood cells, usually beginning in infancy. It may also cause short stature, thumb or facial differences, or heart defects.

Alternate Names:
Diamond-Blackfan Syndrome; Congenital Hypoplastic Anemia

Diamond-Gardner Syndrome

A rare condition in which painful bruises appear repeatedly without a clear injury, most often in women. It is a diagnosis made after other bleeding causes are excluded; old skin tests are not reliable confirmation.

Alternate Names:
Autoerythrocyte Sensitization Syndrome; Painful Bruising Syndrome

Diamorphine

A strong opioid medicine used in selected settings for severe pain or during medical procedures. It can cause sleepiness, nausea, constipation, dependence, and dangerous breathing depression, especially in overdose or with other sedatives.

Dianisidine

An industrial chemical used in some dyes and laboratory reagents. Significant or repeated exposure can irritate tissues and may damage blood or increase cancer risk; workplace protection is important.

Diapedesis

Movement of blood cells, especially infection-fighting white cells, through the walls of tiny blood vessels into nearby tissue. This allows them to reach and respond to infection, injury, or inflammation.

Diaper Rash

Inflammation of skin covered by a diaper, most often irritant contact dermatitis caused by prolonged moisture, urine, stool, occlusion, or friction. Redness usually affects exposed skin and spares the folds; Candida and other skin conditions can also cause rashes in the diaper area.

Alternate Names:
Diaper Dermatitis; Napkin Dermatitis

Diaphoresis

Excessive sweating. It may be a normal response to heat or exercise, or a sign of fever, pain, low blood glucose, anxiety, infection, heart problems, or another condition.

Diaphoretic

Describing heavy sweating or something that causes sweating. Sudden cold sweating with chest pain,

faintness, breathlessness, confusion, or weakness may occur with serious illness.

Diaphragm

The dome-shaped muscle separating the chest from the abdomen and the main muscle used for breathing. When it contracts, it flattens and draws air into the lungs; when it relaxes, air leaves.

Diaphragmatic Crus

One of two musculotendinous bundles (right and left crura) originating from the anterior aspects of the upper lumbar vertebral bodies and fibrocartilaginous discs, ascending to insert into the central tendon of the diaphragm and encircling the esophageal hiatus.

Diaphragmatic Eventration

Abnormal thinning or weakness of part or all of the diaphragm, causing it to sit higher than usual. It may cause no symptoms or lead to breathlessness, especially if severe or present from birth.

Diaphragmatic Hernia

Movement of abdominal organs through a hole or weak area in the diaphragm into the chest. It may be present from birth or follow injury and can impair breathing or cause bowel obstruction.

Diaphragmatic Paralysis

Loss of normal diaphragmatic movement from phrenic-nerve injury, neuromuscular disease, surgery, trauma, or idiopathic causes. Symptoms range from none to breathlessness when lying flat and sleep-related hypoventilation; bilateral disease is more likely to cause respiratory failure.

Diaphragmatic Rupture

A tear in the diaphragm, usually caused by a severe blunt or penetrating injury to the chest or abdomen. Abdominal organs may move into the chest, causing breathing difficulty, obstruction, or strangulation.

Diaphysis

The long central shaft of a bone such as the femur, humerus, or tibia. It contains a hollow marrow cavity and is surrounded by strong compact bone; fractures there may require prolonged healing.

Diarrhea

Passing loose or watery stools more often than usual. Causes include infections, medicines, food intolerance, inflammation, malabsorption, or other illnesses. Diarrhea can lead to dehydration and, when prolonged, malabsorption.

Diarrheal Disease

A group of illnesses that cause repeated loose or watery stools, often because of intestinal infection by viruses, bacteria, or parasites. Severe or persistent episodes can cause dehydration and loss of body salts.

Diarrhea-Predominant IBS

Alternate name; see *IBS-D*.

Diarrhoea

Alternate spelling; see *Diarrhea*.

Diarthrosis

A freely movable joint in which the bones are separated by a space containing lubricating fluid. The knee, hip, shoulder, and elbow are examples.

Diascopy

A clinical examination technique in which a transparent glass slide or plastic lens is pressed firmly against a skin lesion to assess whether it blanches, allowing differentiation between intravascular blood (erythema, telangiectasias, spider naevi) and extravasated red blood cells (purpura, petechiae, ecchymoses).

Diastase

An older name for enzymes that break starch into smaller sugars. Modern medical writing usually uses the term amylase for the related digestive enzyme activity.

Diastasis

Separation or widening between structures that normally lie together. It commonly describes separation of the abdominal muscles after pregnancy and is not itself a true hernia, although both can occur together.

Diastasis Recti

Widening and thinning of the tissue between the two front abdominal muscles, commonly during or after pregnancy or major weight change. It can cause a midline bulge when the abdomen is strained and is not a true hernia.

Diastematomyelia

A birth defect in which the spinal cord is divided into two parts, often by bone or fibrous tissue. It may occur with abnormal vertebrae, a skin mark, weakness, altered sensation, or bladder problems.

Diastole

The part of each heartbeat when the heart muscle relaxes and its chambers fill with blood. The lower blood-pressure number is the pressure in the arteries during this phase.

Diastolic

Relating to diastole, when the heart relaxes and fills. Diastolic blood pressure is the lower number in a blood-pressure reading.

Diastolic Blood Pressure

The pressure in the arteries while the heart relaxes between beats. It is the lower number in a blood-pressure reading and is interpreted with the upper number, symptoms, age, and other health conditions.

Diastolic Dysfunction

Impaired relaxation or filling of a heart ventricle between beats. It may occur with a normal or reduced ejection fraction and does not by itself mean that a person has heart failure; symptoms and evidence of raised filling pressure are also needed to diagnose heart failure.

Diastolic Heart Failure

An older term usually referring to heart failure caused by a stiff heart that does not fill easily, often with preserved pumping percentage. Diagnosis also requires symptoms, signs, and evidence of raised filling pressure.

Diastolic Murmur

An abnormal extra sound heard with a stethoscope between heartbeats, during the resting phase (diastole) when the heart muscle relaxes and fills with blood. Unlike systolic murmurs (which are sometimes harmless), diastolic murmurs almost always indicate an underlying heart valve problem, such as a leaky valve that allows blood to flow backward (regurgitation) or a stiff, narrowed valve that restricts blood flow (stenosis).

Diastolic Murmurs

Plural form; see *Diastolic Murmur*.

Diathermy

Use of high-frequency electrical or electromagnetic energy to produce heat in tissue. It may be used during surgery to cut tissue or stop bleeding, or in selected treatments to warm deeper tissues.

Diathesis

A tendency to develop a particular disease, symptom, or body response. For example, a bleeding diathesis means a person is more likely to bleed than usual.

Diatomaceous Earth

A powder made from the fossilized remains of microscopic algae. Inhalation of fine particles can irritate the lungs, and some forms containing crystalline silica can cause serious lung disease with repeated exposure.

Diatom Test

A forensic test that looks for microscopic algae in tissues after suspected drowning. It may support an investigation but cannot prove drowning by itself because algae can enter the body from other sources.

Diatrizoate Meglumine

An iodinated contrast substance used for selected X-ray or imaging studies. It improves visibility of body structures but may cause allergic-like reactions, kidney injury, aspiration problems, or thyroid effects.

Diazepam

A benzodiazepine that calms brain activity and is used for selected anxiety, muscle-spasm, seizure, and alcohol-withdrawal conditions. It can cause drowsiness, falls, dependence, withdrawal, and dangerous breathing depression with opioids or alcohol.

Diazepam Overdose

Taking too much diazepam can cause extreme sleepiness, confusion, poor coordination, low blood pressure, slowed breathing, coma, or death, especially when combined with alcohol, opioids, or other sedatives.

Diazinon

An organophosphate insecticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase, causing excess nerve signals. Exposure can lead to sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, breathing difficulty, muscle weakness, seizures, or respiratory failure.

Diazinon Poisoning

Poisoning by diazinon, causing excess cholinergic activity with sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, wheezing, slow heartbeat, muscle weakness, seizures, or breathing failure. It requires emergency treatment and decontamination.

Diazonium Compounds

Chemicals containing a diazonium group, used in dyes, synthesis, and laboratory reactions. Some are unstable or toxic and may irritate tissues or release hazardous products.

Diazoxide

A medicine that opens potassium channels and can reduce insulin release or relax blood vessels. It is used in selected cases of low blood sugar from excess insulin and severe high blood pressure; fluid retention and high glucose may occur.

Dibekacin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic used in some regions for serious bacterial infections. It blocks bacterial protein production but can damage the kidneys, hearing, or balance, especially with prolonged or high-dose treatment.

Dibenzepin

A tricyclic antidepressant used in some countries for depressive disorders. It can cause drowsiness, dry mouth, constipation, blurred vision, abnormal heart rhythms, and dangerous toxicity in overdose.

Dibucaine

A long-acting local anesthetic applied to skin or mucous membranes to reduce pain or itching. Excessive use or absorption can cause numbness beyond the treatment area, seizures, heart problems, or other toxicity.

Dicarboxylic Acid

An organic molecule containing two acid groups. These molecules take part in metabolism and may accumulate in some inherited or acquired metabolic disorders.

Dichlorophen

A chemical formerly used in some disinfectants and medicines. Exposure can irritate the skin, eyes, or digestive tract; serious effects depend on the amount, route, and duration of exposure.

Dichlorvos

An organophosphate insecticide that can block acetylcholinesterase. Poisoning may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, muscle weakness, breathing difficulty, seizures, or respiratory failure.

Dichorionic Diamniotic Twin Placenta

A twin pregnancy in which each fetus has its own outer membrane and amniotic sac, usually with a separate placenta. It generally has fewer shared-placenta complications, but routine maternal and

fetal monitoring remains important.

Dichorionic Twins

Twins that each have a separate outer membrane and amniotic sac. Most fraternal twins and some identical twins are dichorionic; risks still include premature birth, growth problems, and pregnancy complications.

Diclofenac

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and inflammation. It can cause stomach irritation or bleeding, kidney or liver injury, fluid retention, and increased cardiovascular risk.

Diclofenac Sodium

A salt form of diclofenac used for pain and inflammation. It can irritate or bleed the stomach and may affect the kidneys, blood pressure, liver, or heart.

Diclofenac Sodium Overdose

Taking too much diclofenac sodium can cause nausea, vomiting, stomach bleeding, kidney injury, drowsiness, seizures, breathing problems, or abnormal body chemistry.

Dicloxacillin

A penicillin-type antibiotic that blocks bacterial cell-wall production. It is used for susceptible infections, especially some staphylococcal infections; allergy, diarrhea, and liver injury can occur.

DICOM

An international format and communication standard for storing, sending, and viewing medical images and related information. It allows images from X-ray, CT, MRI, ultrasound, and other systems to be shared.

Dicoumarol

An older oral anticoagulant that blocks vitamin K recycling and reduces production of several clotting factors. It has largely been replaced by medicines with more predictable effects and remains important mainly historically.

Dicrotic

Describing a second small wave or notch in an artery's pressure pulse, usually produced when the aortic valve closes. It may be visible on a monitor or arterial pressure tracing.

Dicrotophos

An organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase. Poisoning may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, muscle weakness, breathing difficulty, seizures, or respiratory failure.

Dicyclomine

An anticholinergic medicine that relaxes intestinal muscle and may reduce cramping in selected bowel disorders. It can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, fast heartbeat, confusion, or difficulty urinating.

Dieffenbachia Poisoning

Poisoning after chewing or swallowing parts of the Dieffenbachia plant. Needle-like calcium oxalate crystals can cause immediate burning, pain, drooling, and swelling of the mouth and throat; airway swelling requires emergency care.

Diencephalon

A central part of the brain containing the thalamus and hypothalamus. It helps process sensory information and regulate hormones, temperature, appetite, sleep, movement, and other automatic functions.

Dientamoebiasis

Infection of the large intestine with *Dientamoeba fragilis*, a protozoan related to trichomonads. Many people carrying the organism have no symptoms; others have abdominal pain or diarrhea. Its role in symptoms can be uncertain because it is also found in healthy people.

Alternate Names:
Dientamoeba Fragilis Infection

DIEP Flap

A reconstructive surgery using skin and fat from the lower abdomen, supplied by small blood vessels, to rebuild a breast or another body area while preserving most abdominal muscle.

Diesel Oil

A petroleum fuel whose fumes or liquid can irritate the skin, eyes, and lungs. Swallowing or aspiration into the lungs can cause severe chemical pneumonia.

Diestrus

A phase of the reproductive cycle in many mammals between periods of sexual receptivity. It is characterized by activity and later regression of the corpus luteum.

Dietary Assessment

Systematic review of a person's food, drink, nutrient, and supplement intake using methods such as a food diary, recall, or questionnaire. It helps identify deficiencies, excesses, patterns, and changes needed for health.

Dietary Calcium

Calcium obtained from food or drinks, needed for bones, teeth, muscles, nerves, and blood clotting. Requirements vary with age and health; excess supplements may cause kidney stones or other problems.

Dietary Carbohydrate

Carbohydrate in foods and drinks, including sugars, starches, and fiber. Digestible carbohydrate provides energy and affects blood glucose; fiber is only partly or not digested and supports bowel function.

Dietary Fat

An essential nutrient that serves as a concentrated source of energy and is necessary for cellular structure and hormone production. Dietary fats help the body absorb essential fat-soluble vitamins (vitamins A, D, E, and K) and protect vital organs. They are categorized into unsaturated fats (healthy fats commonly found in plant oils, nuts, and fish) and saturated or trans fats, which when consumed in excess can raise cholesterol levels and increase the risk of cardiovascular disease.

Dietary Fats

Plural form; see *Dietary Fat*.

Dietary Fats and Oils

Edible fats and oils, including butter, margarine, and cooking oils, provide energy and essential fatty acids and help the body absorb vitamins A, D, E, and K. Their health effects depend on the type and amount consumed and the overall eating pattern.

Dietary Fiber

Plant material that is not fully digested. It helps form stool, supports regular bowel movements, may improve cholesterol and glucose control, and can increase fullness.

Dietary Fibre

Plant-derived carbohydrate that is not fully digested in the small intestine. Soluble and insoluble fiber support bowel function and may improve cholesterol, glucose control, and fullness; increase intake gradually with adequate fluids unless medically restricted.

Dietary Inflammation

Inflammatory activity that may be influenced by long-term eating patterns, excess body fat, and overall health. Diets rich in vegetables, legumes, whole grains, and unsaturated fats generally support lower inflammation than diets high in heavily processed foods.

Alternate Names:
Diet-Induced Inflammation; Diet-Associated Systemic Inflammation

Dietary Iron

Iron from food or supplements, needed to make hemoglobin, muscle proteins, and enzymes. Too little can cause iron-deficiency anemia; too much can be toxic, especially in children or people with iron-storage disorders.

Dietary Phospholipid

A food-derived fat containing phosphate that helps form cell membranes and transports fats in the blood. Its digestion and handling depend on food intake, absorption, and liver function.

Dietary Phosphorus

Phosphorus from food, needed for bones, teeth, cell membranes, and energy use. People with reduced kidney function may need to limit highly absorbable sources to prevent high blood phosphorus.

Dietary Protein

Protein from food that is digested into amino acids and small peptides. These support muscle and tissue repair, enzymes, hormones, immunity, and energy when needed.

Dietary Reference Intakes

A set of nutrient-intake reference values used to plan and assess diets. They include the recommended allowance, adequate intake, estimated average requirement, and tolerable upper intake level, which vary with age, sex, and life stage.

Dietary Sterol

A cholesterol-like substance found in foods, including cholesterol and plant sterols. Absorption and metabolism affect blood cholesterol; plant sterols can reduce intestinal cholesterol absorption in some people.

Dietary Sugars

Sugars are simple carbohydrates that provide energy but can raise blood glucose and contribute to dental decay or excess calories when consumed in excess.

Dietary Supplement

A manufactured orally ingested product intended to augment the nutritional content of the diet, containing one or more dietary ingredients such as vitamins, essential minerals, amino acids, botanicals/herbal extracts, enzymes, or metabolites. Regulated in many jurisdictions under distinct regulatory frameworks from prescription pharmaceutical drugs, dietary supplements are indicated to correct documented nutritional deficiencies (e.g., vitamin B_{12} in pernicious anemia or vegan diets, vitamin D/calcium in osteopenia, folic acid in preconception), though excessive or unmonitored intake carries risks of toxicities and pharmacodynamic/pharmacokinetic drug-nutrient interactions.

Dietary Supplementation

Deliberate addition of nutrients or other substances to the diet to correct a deficiency, meet increased needs, or support a health goal. Excess amounts can be harmful.

Dietary Supplements

Plural form; see *Dietary Supplement*.

Dietetics

The science and professional practice of using food and nutrition to promote health, prevent disease, and manage medical conditions through individualized dietary advice.

Diethylcarbamazine

An antiparasitic medicine used mainly for lymphatic filariasis and some other filarial infections. Fever, rash, swelling, or inflammation may occur as the immune system reacts to dying parasites.

Diethylhexylphthalate

Another name for DEHP, a chemical added to some plastics to make them flexible. Repeated or high exposure may affect reproduction, development, or hormone function.

Diethylpropion

A stimulant appetite suppressant used short term in selected weight-management plans. It can cause insomnia, anxiety, fast heartbeat, high blood pressure, misuse, and dependence; medical supervision is required.

Diethylstilbestrol

A synthetic estrogen formerly given to some pregnant people. Exposure before birth can increase the risk of reproductive-tract abnormalities, fertility

problems, and certain rare cancers later in life.

Alternate Names:
DES

Dietitian

A nutrition professional who assesses food and nutrient needs and provides individualized advice for health, disease prevention, and medical conditions. Professional titles and licensing rules vary by region.

Dietl Crisis

Severe, episodic, colicky flank or abdominal pain accompanied by nausea, vomiting, and oliguria, caused by transient kinking or obstruction of the ureter when a mobile or ptotic kidney shifts position into the pelvis upon standing (nephroptosis), relieved upon lying supine.

Alternate Names:
Renal Ptosis Crisis; Dietl Syndrome

Diet Therapy

Use of an individualized eating plan to prevent, manage, or treat a health problem. It may address diabetes, kidney disease, food allergy, malnutrition, digestive disorders, or other needs and is tailored to the person's health and goals.

Dieulafoy Lesion

An unusually large artery close to the surface of the stomach or another digestive organ that can suddenly cause severe bleeding, sometimes without a visible ulcer. It may produce vomiting of blood or black stools.

Diff Dx

An abbreviation for differential diagnosis, the structured comparison of possible causes of a person's symptoms, signs, or test results.

Differences Of Sex Development

Variations present from birth in chromosomes, gonads, hormones, or internal or external genital anatomy. Medical evaluation explains the variation, addresses health needs, and supports informed decisions and well-being.

Differential Blood Count

A blood test measuring the numbers or percentages of different white blood cells, including neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils. Results help assess infection, inflammation, allergy, and blood disorders.

Differential Diagnosis

The process of comparing possible diseases or conditions that could explain the same symptoms or findings. Clinicians consider serious causes first, use examination and targeted tests, and revise the possibilities as new information appears.

Differentiated Cancer

A cancer whose cells still resemble the normal tissue from which they arose. The degree of resemblance, called differentiation, helps pathologists describe tumor grade and may provide information about behavior.

Differentiation

The process by which cells develop specialized structures and functions. In cancer pathology, it describes how closely abnormal cells resemble the normal tissue from which they originated.

Differentiation Antigens

Molecules on a cell's surface that indicate its tissue type or stage of development. Laboratory tests for them help identify blood-cell disorders, classify cancers, and guide selected treatments.

Difficult Airway

A situation in which a clinician may have trouble keeping a person breathing or placing a device into the airway. Causes include unusual anatomy, swelling, injury, illness, or limited neck movement and require careful planning.

Difficult Intubation

Difficulty placing a breathing tube in the windpipe despite appropriate technique and equipment. Limited mouth or neck movement, unusual anatomy, swelling, injury, obesity, or a previous difficult intubation may increase risk.

Difficult-to-Control Asthma

Asthma that remains poorly controlled despite appropriate treatment. Possible reasons include ongoing triggers, incorrect inhaler use, another illness, an incorrect diagnosis, severe airway inflammation, or a different response to medicines.

Difficult Urination

Trouble starting or maintaining urine flow, a weak stream, pain, straining, or a feeling of incomplete emptying. Causes include infection, blockage, prostate or pelvic disorders, medicines, and nerve or bladder problems.

Difficulty Speaking

Trouble producing or coordinating speech. It may result from a language problem, weakness or poor coordination of the speech muscles, or a voice disorder; the specific diagnosis depends on the cause.

Difficulty Swallowing

Alternate name; see *Dysphagia*.

Difficulty Swallowing (Dysphagia)

Trouble moving food, liquid, or saliva safely from the mouth to the stomach. Causes may involve the throat, esophagus, nerves, muscles, or obstruction; choking, aspiration, weight loss, or progressive symptoms may indicate significant disease.

Difficulty Walking

Trouble walking safely or normally because of pain, weakness, poor balance, numbness, joint disease, neurologic illness, or heart or lung limitations. Sudden onset may occur with acute neurologic or musculoskeletal disease.

Diffuse

Spread broadly or throughout an area rather than limited to one small, clearly defined focus. The term may describe a disease, pain, swelling, imaging finding, or other process.

Diffuse Aches and Pains

Pain or aching felt in several parts of the body. It can occur with infections, inflammation, some medicines, or other illnesses. The cause depends on the person's other symptoms and health history.

Diffuse Alopecia

Alternate name; see *Diffuse Hair Loss*.

Diffuse Alveolar Hemorrhage

A serious condition in which blood leaks into many of the lung's air sacs. It may cause coughing up blood, breathlessness, low oxygen, falling blood counts, and widespread shadows on a chest scan. Bronchoscopy with increasingly bloody samples can support the diagnosis; clinical findings help identify the cause.

Alternate Names:
DAH; Pulmonary Alveolar Hemorrhage

Diffuse Astrocytoma

An older name for an infiltrating brain tumor made of astrocyte-like cells. Modern classification depends on molecular findings, including IDH status, which help determine diagnosis, outlook, and treatment.

Diffuse Axonal Injury

Widespread damage to brain nerve fibers caused by rapid acceleration, deceleration, or rotation of the head. It can cause prolonged unconsciousness or severe brain dysfunction, and MRI may show the injury.

Diffuse Esophageal Spasm

A disorder in which the esophagus contracts too early or unevenly, causing intermittent chest pain and difficulty swallowing liquids or solids. Testing helps distinguish it from blockage, reflux, and heart disease.

Diffuse Hair Loss

A generalized, non-scarring reduction in hair density or widespread shedding affecting the entire scalp, distinguishing it from focal or patchy alopecia. Major causes include telogen effluvium following physiologic stress or childbirth, anagen effluvium induced by cytotoxic chemotherapy, diffuse androgenetic alopecia, systemic endocrinopathies such as

hypothyroidism, and nutritional deficiencies in iron or zinc.

Alternate Names:
Generalized Alopecia; Diffuse Effluvium

Diffuse Idiopathic Skeletal Hyperostosis

A condition in which extra bone forms along spinal ligaments and where tendons attach to bone. It can cause stiffness, pain, swallowing difficulty, or fractures after minor injury.

Alternate Names:
DISH; Forestier Disease

Diffuse Large B-Cell Lymphoma

A fast-growing cancer of B lymphocytes, a type of white blood cell. It may cause painless swollen lymph nodes, fever, night sweats, or weight loss.

Diffuse Midline Glioma

An aggressive brain or spinal-cord cancer arising in a midline structure, often in children. Symptoms depend on location and may include weakness, movement problems, vision changes, vomiting, or seizures.

Diffuse Parenchymal Lung Disease

Alternate name; see *Interstitial Lung Disease*.

Diffuse Parenchymal Lung Diseases

Alternate index label; see *Interstitial Lung Disease*.

Diffuse Proliferative Glomerulonephritis

A pattern of glomerular inflammation in which many glomeruli show increased cellularity and tissue injury. It often produces hematuria, proteinuria, hypertension, and reduced kidney function and may result from immune-complex disease such as lupus or infection.

Diffuse Scleroderma

A form of systemic sclerosis in which skin thickening extends beyond the hands and face onto the trunk or limbs. It carries a higher risk of lung, kidney, heart, blood-vessel, and digestive complications.

Diffusing Capacity

The ability of the lungs to move oxygen and other gases from the air sacs into the blood. It may be reduced by emphysema, interstitial lung disease, pulmonary vascular disease, or anemia.

Diffusing Capacity Of The Lung

A measure of how efficiently gas crosses from the lung air sacs into nearby blood vessels. It is commonly measured as DLCO and helps evaluate lung tissue, blood vessels, and hemoglobin-related problems.

Diffusion

Movement of molecules from an area where they are more concentrated to an area where they are less concentrated, caused by their random motion. It helps exchange gases and substances in the body.

Diffusion Anisotropy

A difference in the direction water moves through tissue, especially along nerve fibers in the brain. MRI can use this pattern to study nerve-fiber structure and injury.

Diffusion Capacity

A measure of how efficiently gases pass from lung air sacs into blood. It is commonly reported as DLCO and may be reduced in interstitial lung disease, emphysema, pulmonary vascular disease, or anemia.

Diffusion Restriction

An area where water movement appears reduced on a special MRI sequence. It can occur with an acute stroke, abscess, densely packed tumor, seizure, or other problem; significance depends on the full examination.

Diffusion Tensor Imaging

An MRI technique that maps the direction of water movement along nerve fibers. It helps show the paths and condition of important nerve connections in the brain.

Diffusion-Weighted Imaging

An MRI technique that shows how water molecules move within tissue. Areas with restricted movement may occur in acute stroke, abscess, densely packed tumors, seizures, or other conditions.

Diflunisal

A salicylate nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and inflammation. It can cause stomach irritation or bleeding, kidney injury, fluid retention, allergic reactions, or cardiovascular problems.

Digastric Muscle

A two-part muscle beneath the jaw that helps open the mouth, lower the jaw, and raise the hyoid bone during swallowing and speech.

DiGeorge Syndrome

A genetic disorder usually caused by loss of a small part of chromosome 22. It can affect the heart, immune system, calcium regulation, palate, hearing, learning, and development.

Alternate Names:
22q11.2 Deletion Syndrome

Digestion

The process of breaking food into smaller substances that the body can absorb and use. It begins in the mouth and continues through the stomach and intestines with movement, acid, bile, and digestive enzymes.

Digestive Diseases

Disorders affecting the digestive tract, liver, gallbladder, or pancreas. Examples include reflux, ulcers, infections, inflammatory bowel disease, blockage, malabsorption, and cancer.

Digestive Disorder

A disease affecting the digestive tract or the process of digestion. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea, reflux, diarrhea, constipation, bleeding, vomiting, or poor nutrient absorption.

Digestive Health

Healthy function of the digestive tract in breaking down food, absorbing nutrients and water, and removing waste. It is influenced by diet, fluids, medicines, movement, illness, and the gut lining and microbiome.

Alternate Names:
Gut Health

Digestive System

The gastrointestinal tract and accessory organs that mechanically and chemically process food, absorb nutrients and water, and eliminate solid waste. It includes the mouth, pharynx, esophagus, stomach, small and large intestines, rectum, anus, liver, gallbladder, and pancreas.

Digestive Tract

The continuous hollow passage through which food travels from the mouth to the anus. It includes the throat, esophagus, stomach, small intestine, large intestine, rectum, and anus.

Alternate Names:
Gastrointestinal Tract; Alimentary Canal

Digit

A finger or toe. Most fingers and toes contain three small bones, while the thumb and great toe usually contain two; muscles, tendons, nerves, and blood vessels allow movement and sensation.

Digital Anorectal Examination

A physical examination in which a clinician uses a lubricated, gloved finger to evaluate the anal canal, distal rectum, sphincter muscle tone, and adjacent structures such as the prostate.

Alternate Names:
DARE; Digital Rectal Examination; DRE; Rectal Exam

Digital Breast Tomosynthesis

A breast X-ray test that takes pictures from several angles and combines them into thin, layered images. It can show some breast findings more clearly than a single flat image.

Digital Clubbing

Enlargement and rounding of the fingertips with curved nails and loss of the normal angle at the nail base. It may be associated with lung, heart, digestive, liver, or other diseases.

Digital Fibrokeratoma

A rare, harmless, firm skin growth usually found on a finger or toe. It may resemble a wart; removal or microscopic examination may be needed when its appearance is unusual or it causes pain or interference.

Digitalis

A group of cardiac glycosides, including digoxin, that can increase cardiac contractility and slow atrioventricular conduction; toxicity may cause gastrointestinal, neurologic, visual, or cardiac-rhythm effects.

Digital Ischemia

Too little blood flow to a finger or toe, causing pain, pallor, coolness, numbness, or tissue death. It may result from arterial blockage, severe Raynaud phenomenon, inflammation, or an embolus and can be an emergency.

Digitalis Preparation

A preparation containing a cardiac glycoside such as digoxin or digitoxin. It can strengthen heart contraction and slow electrical conduction, but the dose range is narrow and toxicity can cause digestive, visual, or rhythm problems.

Digitalis Toxicity

Harmful effects from digitalis or related cardiac glycosides, including nausea, vomiting, visual changes, confusion, slow or fast abnormal heart rhythms, and high potassium. Kidney disease and drug interactions increase risk.

Digital Mammography

Breast imaging that records X-ray pictures electronically. It helps detect masses, distortions, and calcium deposits and allows images to be enlarged, adjusted, stored, and compared.

Digital Mucous Cyst

A usually harmless fluid-filled lump near the last joint of a finger, often linked to osteoarthritis. It may press on the nail, cause pain, or occasionally become infected.

Digital Papillary Adenocarcinoma

A rare cancer of a sweat gland, usually on a finger, hand, or foot. It often appears as a slow-growing lump but can return locally or spread to other organs.

Digital Radiography

X-ray imaging in which the picture is captured electronically instead of on film. The image can be viewed, stored, adjusted, and shared on a computer.

Digital Rectal Exam

A physical examination using a lubricated, gloved finger to feel the anal canal and rectum and, when relevant, the prostate. It may detect tenderness, bleeding, lumps, hemorrhoids, or muscle problems.

Digital Rectal Examination

An examination in which a clinician gently feels inside the rectum with a lubricated, gloved finger. It may check for pain, bleeding, lumps, hemorrhoids, prostate changes, or muscle problems after explanation and consent.

Digital Subtraction Angiography

An X-ray study in which computer processing removes background structures from contrast images so blood vessels are clearer. It can diagnose narrowing or blockage and guide selected vascular procedures.

Digitate Warts

Finger-like or thread-like warts, usually on the face or neck, caused by human papillomavirus infection. They are generally harmless but can spread or recur.

Alternate Names:
Verruca Digitata

Digitoxin

A cardiac glycoside that can strengthen heart contraction and slow electrical conduction. Its safe and toxic doses are close together, so abnormal rhythms, digestive symptoms, visual changes, and drug interactions are important concerns.

Digoxin

A cardiac medicine used in selected people with heart failure or atrial fibrillation. It can strengthen contraction and slow the heart rate, but kidney function, electrolytes, other medicines, and blood levels affect toxicity risk.

Digoxin Immune Fab

Antibody fragments given by injection that bind digoxin and related cardiac glycosides, reducing their effects. They are used for life-threatening abnormal rhythms, severe toxicity, or a potentially very large ingestion.

Digoxin Test

A blood test measuring digoxin concentration to help guide dosing or assess possible toxicity. Timing, symptoms, kidney function, electrolytes, and interacting medicines affect interpretation; the number alone does not prove toxicity.

Digoxin Toxicity

Poisoning from digoxin or related heart medicines. It may cause nausea, vomiting, confusion, vision changes, or a slow, fast, or irregular heartbeat. Severe toxicity can be life-threatening.

Dihydrocodeine

An opioid medicine used for selected pain or cough conditions. It can cause constipation, nausea, drowsiness, dependence, dangerous breathing depression, and overdose, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Dihydroergotamine

An ergot medicine used for selected acute migraine attacks. It narrows certain blood vessels and is contraindicated in several vascular, heart, liver, kidney, and pregnancy-related conditions.

Dihydropyrimidine Dehydrogenase Deficiency (DPYD-Related)

Reduced activity of dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase, usually caused by harmful variants in the DPYD gene. It can impair breakdown of fluorouracil and related medicines and greatly increase the risk of severe or life-threatening toxicity.

Dihydrotestosterone

A potent androgen made from testosterone. It contributes to development of male external genitalia, facial and body hair, prostate growth, and other androgen effects.

Dihydroxyacetone

A three-carbon sugar involved in metabolism. Its phosphate form is an intermediate used when cells break down glucose or make glucose.

Dilantin Overdose

Taking too much phenytoin can cause involuntary eye movements, poor coordination, slurred speech, drowsiness, confusion, low blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, seizures, or coma.

Dilatation

Alternate spelling; see *Dilation*.

Dilate

To become wider or make a passage, blood vessel, opening, or body structure wider. Dilation may occur naturally, result from medicines or disease, or be created during a procedure.

Alternate Names:
Expand; Enlarge

Dilated Cardiomyopathy

A heart-muscle disease in which one or more chambers enlarge and pump weakly. Causes include inherited disease, infection, toxins, medicines, pregnancy, blocked arteries, and inflammation; it can lead to heart failure or abnormal rhythms.

Alternate Names:
DCM; Congestive Cardiomyopathy

Dilated Cardiomyopathy Prognosis

Outlook varies with heart-pumping strength, symptoms, cause, abnormal rhythms, other illnesses, and response to treatment. Medicines and devices can improve function for some people; severe disease may require advanced heart-failure care.

Dilated Pore of Winer

A benign, enlarged opening of a hair follicle that appears as a solitary black or dark keratin-filled pore, usually on the face, neck, or trunk of an adult. It may resemble a skin tumour; complete removal is diagnostic and usually curative.

Dilation

Widening or expansion of a hollow organ, blood vessel, duct, pupil, opening, or other body structure. It may be normal, caused by disease, or deliberately produced during a procedure.

Dilation and Curettage

A procedure that opens the cervix and removes tissue from inside the uterus using suction or an instrument. It may treat miscarriage or retained pregnancy tissue, investigate bleeding, or remove abnormal tissue; risks include bleeding, infection, and perforation.

Dilation And Evacuation

A procedure that opens the cervix and removes pregnancy tissue from the uterus using suction and instruments. It is performed by trained clinicians for selected pregnancy-related indications, with risks including bleeding, infection, and uterine injury.

Dilator

An instrument or device used to widen a body opening or passage gradually or temporarily. It may be used during examinations, surgery, childbirth care, dental treatment, or treatment of a narrowing.

Diltiazem

A calcium-channel blocker used for high blood pressure, angina, and heart-rate control in some abnormal rhythms. It can slow the heart, lower blood pressure, cause constipation, or worsen heart failure in susceptible people.

Dilute Russell Viper Venom Time

A blood-clotting test used mainly to detect lupus anticoagulant, an antibody associated with antiphospholipid syndrome. Anticoagulant medicines and other clotting problems can affect the result, so confirmatory testing is needed.

Dilution

Lowering the concentration of a substance by adding solvent or another fluid. Accurate dilution is important when preparing medicines, laboratory reagents, standards, or specimens.

Dilution Anemia

A pseudoanemia caused by an expansion of plasma volume out of proportion to red blood cell mass, resulting in reduced hemoglobin concentration and hematocrit despite normal total circulating erythrocyte volume, typically seen during pregnancy and aggressive intravenous fluid administration.

Alternate Names:
Hypervolemic Anemia; Hemodilution

Dimenhydrinate

An antihistamine used to prevent or treat motion sickness and nausea. It can cause drowsiness, dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, confusion, or difficulty urinating.

Dimenhydrinate Overdose

Taking too much dimenhydrinate can cause severe drowsiness or agitation, confusion, hallucinations, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, breathing depression, or coma.

Dimercaprol

An injected medicine that binds certain toxic metals, including arsenic, mercury, and gold, so the body can remove them. It can cause high blood pressure, fast heartbeat, nausea, pain, and other adverse effects.

Dimesna

A sulfur-containing compound studied as a protective or detoxifying medicine, including in some chemotherapy-related settings. Its clinical role depends on the specific treatment and available evidence.

Dimethoate

An organophosphate insecticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase. Poisoning can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle weakness, breathing problems, seizures, or coma.

Dimethoxon

A poisonous breakdown product of some organophosphate pesticides. It can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle twitching, weakness, breathing difficulty, or seizures.

Dimethyl Fumarate

An oral medicine used for multiple sclerosis and selected skin conditions. It can cause flushing, digestive symptoms, low white-cell counts, liver injury, allergic reactions, or rare serious infections.

Dimethyl Fumarate Allergy

An allergic or hypersensitivity reaction to dimethyl fumarate, a medicine used for some forms of multiple sclerosis. It may cause rash, itching, swelling, breathing difficulty, or other immune symptoms.

Dimethylhydrazines

A group of highly toxic chemicals formerly used mainly in rocket fuel. Exposure can irritate or burn tissues and damage the nervous system, liver, blood, or other organs.

Dimethyl Sulfoxide

An organic solvent used in laboratories and some specialized medical or investigational applications. Contact or ingestion can irritate tissues, and it may carry other substances through the skin.

Dimethyl Sulphoxide

Another spelling of dimethyl sulfoxide, an organic solvent used in laboratories and selected medical or investigational applications. Exposure may cause irritation, a characteristic odor, or other adverse effects.

Dimetilan

A poisonous carbamate insecticide that disrupts nerve signals by blocking acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause sweating, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, weakness, breathing difficulty, seizures, or coma.

Diminished Ovarian Reserve

Fewer remaining eggs than expected for a person's age, which may reduce response to fertility treatment and shorten the time available for conception. Tests estimate reserve but cannot precisely predict natural fertility.

Alternate Names:
Decreased Ovarian Reserve; DOR

Dimocillin

A penicillin-type antibiotic used historically or in selected settings for susceptible bacterial infections. Choice depends on the organism, resistance testing, infection site, allergies, and local treatment guidance.

Dimorphic

Existing in two distinct forms. Some fungi are dimorphic, growing as a mold in the environment and as a yeast in body tissues; this ability can contribute to infection.

Dinophyceae

A group of aquatic microorganisms, including dinoflagellates. Some produce toxins during harmful algal blooms that can contaminate seafood or water and cause neurologic, digestive, or liver illness.

Dinoprost

A prostaglandin medicine that stimulates uterine contraction and other smooth-muscle effects. It is

used mainly in veterinary medicine and selected reproductive-health settings; pain, diarrhea, breathing difficulty, and blood-pressure changes may occur.

Dinoprostone

A prostaglandin medicine used to soften the cervix and help start labor or manage selected pregnancy-related conditions. It requires obstetric monitoring because it can cause contractions that are too frequent, pain, fever, nausea, or fetal heart-rate changes.

Dinucleoside Phosphates

Molecules containing two nucleosides joined by phosphate groups. They occur in nucleotide metabolism and may take part in cellular signaling, energy transfer, or DNA and RNA-related reactions.

Dinutuximab

An antibody-based cancer medicine that attaches to a marker found on many neuroblastoma cells and helps the immune system destroy them. It can cause severe nerve pain, allergic reactions, fever, and fluid leakage from blood vessels.

Dioctyl Sodium Sulphosuccinate

A surfactant and stool-softening medicine also called docusate sodium. It helps water mix with stool and is used in selected constipation settings, although evidence of benefit is limited.

Diopter

A unit of optical power equal to the reciprocal of focal length in meters. Eyeglass and contact-lens prescriptions use diopters to state the strength needed to focus light clearly.

Dioxin

A group of long-lasting environmental chemicals produced by some industrial processes and burning. They can build up in body fat; long-term exposure may affect development, reproduction, immunity, hormones, and cancer risk.

Dipeptide

A molecule made of two amino acids joined together. Dipeptides are produced during protein digestion and metabolism and can be absorbed or used in further chemical reactions.

Dipeptidyl Peptidase-4 Inhibitors

Oral diabetes medicines that prolong the action of natural gut hormones. They help the body release insulin after meals and reduce glucagon, usually without causing weight gain or low blood glucose when used alone.

Dipetalonema Infection

Infection with a Dipetalonema parasitic worm, usually acquired through an arthropod bite. It may affect skin or tissue beneath the skin; diagnosis and treatment depend on the species and clinical findings.

Didelphys Uterus

Alternate name; see *Uterus Didelphys*.

Diphallia

A rare birth condition in which the penis is partly or completely duplicated. Abnormalities of the urinary tract, anus, spine, or other organs may also occur and require specialist assessment.

Diphenhydramine

An antihistamine with sedating and anticholinergic effects used in some allergy or sleep products. It can impair alertness and cause dry mouth, confusion, urinary retention, abnormal rhythms, or toxicity in overdose.

Diphenhydramine Overdose

Taking too much diphenhydramine can cause severe drowsiness or agitation, confusion, hallucinations, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, breathing depression, coma, or death.

Diphenoxylate

An opioid-related medicine that slows intestinal movement to reduce diarrhea, usually combined

with atropine. Excessive use can cause drowsiness, constipation, dependence, breathing depression, or poisoning.

Diphosphate

A chemical group containing two linked phosphate units. Diphosphate is involved in energy use, nucleotide formation, and other chemical reactions in cells.

Diphosphonate

A chemical group found in compounds that can bind strongly to bone mineral. Some related medicines are used or studied for disorders of bone breakdown and calcium balance.

Diphtheria

An infection caused by certain types of *Corynebacterium diphtheriae* bacteria that make a toxin. Infection of the throat or nose can form a thick gray coating that makes breathing or swallowing difficult. The toxin can also damage the heart, nerves, or other organs; skin infection may cause sores.

Diphtheria Toxin

A poisonous protein made by some Corynebacterium bacteria. It blocks protein production inside cells, causing local tissue injury and potentially severe heart, nerve, and airway complications.

Diphtheroid Bacillus

A rod-shaped bacterium resembling Corynebacterium under the microscope. Many are normal skin bacteria or contaminants, but some can cause opportunistic infection in people with serious illness or medical devices.

Diphyllobothriasis

An intestinal infection caused by a fish tapeworm acquired from raw or undercooked freshwater fish. It may cause abdominal symptoms and, rarely, vitamin B12 deficiency and anemia.

Diphyllobothrium Latum

A fish tapeworm acquired by eating raw or undercooked freshwater fish. It lives in the intestine and may cause abdominal symptoms or compete for vitamin B12, occasionally leading to anemia.

Diplacusis

Hearing one sound as two different pitches or qualities. It often reflects unequal hearing between the ears or inner-ear dysfunction and may follow infection, noise injury, or other ear disease.

Diplegia

Severe weakness or paralysis affecting matching parts on both sides of the body. In spastic diplegia, the legs are affected more than the arms, often because of early brain injury.

Diplococcus

A bacterium that appears as pairs of round cells under a microscope. The term describes shape, not one species; some diplococci cause infections in people.

Diploid Cell

A cell containing two complete sets of chromosomes, one inherited from each parent. Most human body cells are diploid; eggs and sperm normally contain only one set.

Diploidy

Having two complete sets of chromosomes, usually one from each parent. This is the normal chromosome state of most human body cells.

Diplopia

Seeing two images instead of one. It may affect one eye or happen only when both eyes are open. Causes include eye problems, misaligned eye muscles, nerve or muscle conditions, and brain disorders.

Alternate Names:
Double Vision

Dipole

A pair of equal and opposite electrical or magnetic charges separated by a distance. The concept is used in physiology, medical imaging, and physics to

describe electrical or magnetic fields.

Dipper

A person whose blood pressure falls during sleep, usually by about 10 percent or more compared with daytime readings. The pattern is measured with a portable 24-hour monitor and may help assess cardiovascular risk.

Diprosopus

A rare birth defect in which part or all of the face is duplicated. It usually occurs with severe abnormalities of the brain, heart, or other organs and often causes major developmental problems.

Dipsosis

Excessive thirst or a persistent urge to drink. Causes include dehydration, high blood glucose, high blood concentration, medicines, dry mouth, or disorders affecting thirst regulation.

Dipstick Device

A strip or small device containing chemical pads that change color when placed in a specimen, commonly urine. It provides a rapid screen for substances such as blood, protein, glucose, or infection markers.

Diptera

The insect order containing flies and mosquitoes. Some species spread infections through bites or contamination, while others can cause infestations such as myiasis.

Dipylidium Caninum

A tapeworm of dogs and cats that can occasionally infect people, especially children, after an infected flea is swallowed. Infection may cause mild digestive symptoms or visible worm segments in stool.

Dipyridamole

A medicine that reduces platelet clumping and widens blood vessels. It is used in selected stroke-prevention plans and heart stress testing; headache, dizziness, low blood pressure, and bleeding may occur.

Direct Acting Antivirals

Medicines that directly block steps in a virus's life cycle. The term is often used for combination treatments for hepatitis C that target viral proteins and can cure most infections.

Alternate Names:
DAAs

Direct Action

An effect produced through an intervention's immediate target, without requiring an intermediate pathway or mediator. The term may describe a medicine, hormone, nerve signal, or other biological process.

Direct Antiglobulin Test

A blood test that detects antibodies or complement attached to a person's red blood cells. A positive result may occur with autoimmune hemolysis, a transfusion reaction, or hemolysis affecting a newborn.

Direct Coombs Test

Another name for the direct antiglobulin test, which detects antibodies or complement attached to red blood cells. It can help investigate autoimmune hemolysis, transfusion reactions, medicine-related hemolysis, or newborn hemolysis.

Direct Hernia

An inguinal hernia in which abdominal tissue pushes through a weak area in the back wall of the groin canal. It may cause a groin lump or discomfort and can occasionally become trapped.

Direct Inguinal Hernia

An abdominal wall hernia in which peritoneal sac contents protrude directly forward through a weakened transversalis fascia within Hesselbach triangle, situated medial to the inferior epigastric vessels.

Directly Observed Therapy

A healthcare worker or trained supporter watches a person take each dose of medicine. It can support completion of complex treatment, especially

for tuberculosis, and helps detect adverse effects or missed doses.

Direct Oral Anticoagulants

Oral blood thinners that directly block a clotting protein, such as thrombin or factor Xa. They prevent and treat clots but can cause bleeding and require attention to kidney function, interactions, and procedures.

Direct Transmission

Spread of an infectious organism through immediate contact or short-range respiratory droplets from an infected person or animal, without an intermediate object, food, water source, or vector.

Direct Veneer

A tooth-colored composite layer shaped and hardened directly on a tooth to improve appearance or repair minor damage. It usually preserves more tooth than some alternatives but may stain, chip, or need replacement.

Alternate Names:
Direct Composite Veneer; Composite Dental Veneer

Dirofilaria Repens

A mosquito-transmitted parasitic worm that rarely infects people. It usually causes a single lump beneath the skin or near the eye because humans are an accidental host; it does not usually mature or spread in the body.

Dirt-Eating

Repeatedly eating soil or other nonfood substances, a form of pica. It may be associated with iron deficiency, pregnancy, nutritional problems, or mental health conditions and can expose a person to infection or toxins.

Dirty Necrosis

Dead tumor tissue mixed with broken cell material and many white blood cells. It is often seen in rapidly growing cancers and is interpreted by a pathologist with the rest of the tissue sample.

Disability

A difficulty with body function, activity, or participation caused by a health condition and influenced by the person's environment. Disability may be temporary or lifelong and varies in severity and support needs.

Disability-Adjusted Life Year

A population-health measure combining years lost from early death with years lived in less than full health. One DALY represents one lost year of healthy life under the method used.

Disability Evaluation

An assessment of how a health condition affects physical, mental, or daily functioning. History, examination, records, and appropriate tests may inform decisions about work, benefits, insurance, rehabilitation, or support.

Disaccharidase

An intestinal enzyme that breaks a double sugar into simple sugars that can be absorbed. Lactase, for example, breaks lactose in milk into glucose and galactose.

Disaccharide

A carbohydrate made of two linked simple sugars, such as lactose, sucrose, or maltose. It must be split by digestive enzymes before the intestine can absorb its component sugars.

Disarticulation

Amputation performed through a joint rather than by cutting through the shaft of a bone. The level is chosen according to the injury, disease, circulation, function, and possibility of healing.

Disc

A thin, round structure. In the spine, an intervertebral disc is a tough, flexible cushion between neighboring vertebrae that absorbs load and allows movement.

Discectomy

Surgery to remove part of a damaged spinal disc that is pressing on a nerve. It may relieve leg or arm pain and weakness, but risks include infection, bleeding, nerve injury, and recurrent disc problems.

Discitis

Inflammation or infection of a spinal disc, often involving the nearby vertebral bones. It may cause severe localized back or neck pain, stiffness, fever, or reduced movement and usually requires imaging and medical evaluation.

Discography

An imaging procedure in which contrast is injected into a spinal disc to examine it and see whether the injection reproduces pain. Because it has limitations and risks, it is used selectively.

Discoid

Coin-shaped or round. In medicine, it often describes a skin lesion or rash, such as the round plaques of discoid lupus; the associated condition must be identified separately.

Discoid Eczema

A long-lasting type of eczema that causes itchy, round or oval patches of inflamed skin, which may blister, ooze, crust, or become dry and cracked. It can affect different parts of the body and sometimes becomes infected.

Alternate Names:
Nummular Eczema; Discoid Dermatitis; Nummular Dermatitis

Discoid Lupus

Alternate name; see *Discoid Lupus Erythematosus*.

Discoid Lupus Erythematosus

A chronic scarring form of cutaneous lupus that causes persistent, scaly plaques, commonly on the scalp, face, and ears. Lesions may heal with skin atrophy, pigment change, and permanent hair loss in affected areas. Some people also have or later develop systemic lupus erythematosus.

Discoloration

An unusual change in the color of skin, mucous membranes, nails, or another tissue. Causes include bruising, low oxygen, jaundice, inflammation, infection, or altered pigment; changes may be sudden, painful, widespread, or unexplained.

Discolored Teeth

Alternate name; see *Tooth Discoloration*.

Discoloured Teeth

Alternate spelling; see *Tooth Discoloration*.

Discomfort

An unpleasant physical or emotional sensation that may be milder or less clearly located than pain. Its importance depends on the site, duration, associated symptoms, and underlying cause.

Discordance

Lack of agreement between findings, measurements, genetic results, or the medical conditions of two related people. The significance depends on what is being compared and the clinical setting.

Discordant

Not agreeing, matching, or corresponding. In medicine it may describe conflicting test results or different medical findings in related people, twins, or paired organs.

Discordant Couple

A couple whose partners have different results or medical statuses relevant to their care, such as one partner having HIV and the other not. Counseling can reduce transmission risk and support reproductive decisions.

Disease

An abnormal condition that affects the body or mind and changes normal structure or function. Diseases may be infectious, inflammatory, inherited, degenerative, metabolic, immune-related, or cancerous.

Disease-Free Survival

The length of time after treatment during which a person remains alive without detectable evidence of the disease. The exact definition and assessment method depend on the disease and study.

Disease Progression

Change in a disease over time, often meaning worsening. It is assessed through symptoms, examination, laboratory results, imaging, function, complications, and response to treatment.

Disease Reporting

Notification of specified diseases, infections, or health events to public-health authorities. Reports help detect outbreaks, protect contacts, arrange follow-up, and monitor health patterns; requirements vary by location.

Disease Reservoir

A person, animal, environment, or material in which an infectious organism normally lives and from which it can spread to a susceptible host.

Disease Response

The body's biological or clinical reaction to a disease or its treatment. It is assessed using symptoms, signs, laboratory results, imaging, physical function, or survival.

Disease Surveillance

Ongoing collection, analysis, interpretation, and reporting of health information to detect, monitor, and respond to disease patterns, outbreaks, and changes in population health.

Disease Susceptibility

Increased likelihood of developing a disease because of genes, age, immune status, exposures, behavior, other illnesses, or environmental factors. Susceptibility raises risk but does not mean disease is certain.

Disease Vector

A living carrier, commonly a mosquito, tick, flea, or other arthropod, that transfers an infectious organism between hosts. The vector may transmit infection without becoming ill itself.

Disfigurement

A visible change that substantially alters appearance, caused by injury, disease, surgery, a birth difference, or scarring. Its physical, emotional, and social effects vary between people.

Disinfectant

A chemical or physical agent used on nonliving surfaces to destroy or inactivate many microorganisms. Disinfectants are not necessarily safe for skin, wounds, food, or internal use.

Disinfection

A process that inactivates many or most disease-causing microorganisms on nonliving objects. Unlike cleaning, it does not primarily remove soil and germs; cleaning is usually needed first. Disinfection may not destroy bacterial spores, and its effectiveness depends on the agent, organism, surface, and exposure conditions.

Disk

A flat, round structure. In the spine, an intervertebral disk lies between neighboring vertebrae, absorbs shock, and helps the back move.

Alternate Names:
Disc

Disk Battery Ingestion

Ingestion of a button or coin battery, which can cause rapid electrical and chemical tissue injury, especially when lodged in the esophagus. It is a medical emergency requiring urgent localization and removal.

Disk Diffusion Susceptibility Test

A laboratory test of bacterial antibiotic sensitivity. Drug-containing disks are placed on growing bacteria, and the clear areas around them are measured and compared with standards to guide treatment.

Diskectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of a damaged spinal disk pressing on a nerve or the spinal cord. It may relieve pain or weakness caused by disk herniation; risks include infection, bleeding, nerve injury, and recurrence.

Diskitis

Inflammation or infection of a spinal disk and nearby vertebral bone. It commonly causes severe localized back pain, stiffness, fever, or reluctance to move; imaging can show the affected area.

Dislocated Ankle

Alternate name; see *Ankle Dislocation*.

Dislocated Elbow

Loss of normal alignment of the elbow joint, usually after a fall or collision. It causes severe pain, deformity, and limited movement and may occur with fractures, nerve injury, or impaired circulation.

Dislocated Hip

Displacement of the upper thighbone from its hip socket, usually after major trauma or around an artificial joint. It is an emergency because nearby nerves and the blood supply to the bone may be damaged.

Dislocated Knee

Loss of alignment between the thighbone and shinbone, usually after severe injury. Major artery or nerve damage may be hidden, so urgent reduction and circulation checks are needed even if the knee returns to position.

Dislocated Shoulder

Displacement of the upper arm bone from the shoulder socket. It causes pain, deformity, and inability to move normally and requires reduction with assessment of nerves, blood vessels, and fractures.

Dislocation

Complete loss of normal contact between the surfaces of a joint, usually from injury or disease. It can cause severe pain and deformity and may occur with fractures or nerve and blood-vessel injury.

Dislocation Of The Lens

Partial or complete movement of the eye's natural lens away from its normal position because its supporting fibers are weak or torn. It may cause blurred or double vision, eye pain, or glaucoma.

Disofenin Scan

A nuclear-imaging test that follows bile production and flow through the liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts. It can help detect blockage, leakage, inflammation, or selected causes of abdominal pain.

Disopyramide

An antiarrhythmic medicine used selectively for certain abnormal heart rhythms. It can slow electrical conduction and weaken heart contraction and may cause dry mouth, urinary retention, low blood pressure, or new arrhythmias.

Disorder

A disturbance of normal body or mind structure or function that causes symptoms, impairment, or important health risk. The term does not by itself indicate how severe the problem is.

Disordered Thinking

A disturbance in the organization, clarity, logic, or flow of thoughts. It may occur with mental illness, brain disease, delirium, substance use, medicines, or other medical conditions.

Disorders of Fluid, Electrolyte, and Acid-Base Balance

Disorders that disturb body-fluid balance, electrolyte concentrations, or blood acidity. They may arise from kidney, heart, endocrine, gastrointestinal, medication, or critical-illness problems and can affect the brain, muscles, and heart.

Disorders of Oral Pigmentation

Conditions causing focal or diffuse dark, brown, blue, or black discoloration of the mouth lining. Causes

include normal variation, trauma, inflammation, medicines, smoking, endocrine or systemic disease, and melanocytic or other tumors; new, changing, solitary, or symptomatic lesions need oral examination.

Disorganized Symptoms in Schizophrenia

Markedly disorganized speech, behavior, or emotional expression occurring in schizophrenia. Modern classifications describe these features within schizophrenia-spectrum disorders rather than as a separate subtype.

Alternate Names:
Disorganized Schizophrenia (deprecated historical subtype label)

Disorientation

Difficulty knowing the time, place, situation, or one's identity. It may occur with delirium, infection, abnormal body chemistry, intoxication or withdrawal, brain injury, or dementia; sudden onset can accompany acute illness.

Dispensary

A place or service that stores, prepares, and supplies medicines and may provide basic medication advice. Safe dispensing includes checking the prescription, labeling the medicine, and explaining how to use it.

Dispensed Amount

The quantity of medicine supplied to a patient. It is determined by the prescribed dose, treatment duration, formulation, refill rules, and applicable safety or legal requirements.

Dispensing

The professional process of checking a prescription, selecting and preparing the medicine, labeling it, and supplying it with instructions for safe use.

Displacement

Movement of an anatomical structure away from its normal position, as in a displaced fracture, joint injury, organ shift, or device migration. Effects depend on the structure involved and the amount of movement.

Disruption

An interruption or breakdown of normal structure, function, continuity, or process. In medicine, it may describe damaged tissue, a broken barrier, disturbed development, or an interruption in the usual work of an organ or system.

Disruptive Mood Dysregulation Disorder

A childhood mental disorder characterized by persistent, severe irritability and frequent, developmentally inappropriate temper outbursts occurring several times per week.

Disruptive, Impulse-Control, and Conduct Disorders

A group of disorders involving persistent problems with emotional or behavioral self-control that violate the rights of others, major age-appropriate rules, or social norms. Examples include oppositional defiant disorder, conduct disorder, intermittent explosive disorder, kleptomania, and pyromania.

Dissect

To separate tissue layers or structures by cutting or careful blunt separation for surgery, examination, or anatomical study.

Dissecting Aneurysm

Alternate name; see *Aortic Dissection*.

Dissection

Separation of tissue layers, either during surgery or because of disease. In an artery, a tear in the inner lining lets blood split the wall layers and can block blood flow or cause the artery to rupture.

Disseminate

To spread widely through the body, a tissue, or a population. Infection, cancer, inflammation, or another process may disseminate rather than remain in one limited area.

Disseminated Bartonellosis

Bartonella infection that spreads through the bloodstream and affects multiple tissues or organs. It

may cause fever and weight loss, with manifestations such as vascular skin lesions, bacillary peliosis of the liver or spleen, bone infection, eye disease, or endocarditis. Severe forms, including bacillary angiomatosis and peliosis, occur mainly in people with weakened immune systems.

Disseminated Coccidioidomycosis

A fungal infection in which Coccidioides spreads beyond the lungs to skin, bones, joints, brain coverings, or other organs. It can be severe and is more likely in people with impaired immunity.

Disseminated Cutaneous Blastomycosis

A Blastomyces infection that spreads from the lungs or another site to multiple areas of skin. It may also involve bones or other organs and requires antifungal treatment.

Disseminated Gonococcal Infection

A systemic complication of Neisseria gonorrhoeae infection resulting from bacteremic dissemination from mucosal surfaces. It classically manifests as an arthritis-dermatitis syndrome (migratory polyarthralgias, tenosynovitis, and painless pustular or hemorrhagic skin lesions) or as acute purulent septic monoarthritis.

Alternate Names:
DGI

Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation

A severe, life-threatening disorder of blood clotting triggered by major medical emergencies such as widespread infection (sepsis), severe trauma, burns, or pregnancy complications. The condition causes tiny blood clots to form throughout small blood vessels across the body, blocking blood flow to vital organs. As the body exhausts its clotting proteins and platelets, dangerous, uncontrollable bleeding can occur from puncture sites, gums, or internal organs.

Alternate Names:
DIC

Disseminated Mycobacterium Avium–Intracellulare Infection

A widespread infection with Mycobacterium avium complex, usually in people with severe immune suppression. It may involve blood, bone marrow, lymph nodes, liver, spleen, or other organs.

Disseminated Neuroblastoma

Neuroblastoma that has spread from its original site to distant organs, bone marrow, bones, liver, or lymph nodes. Treatment and outlook depend on age, spread, tumor biology, and response to specialist care.

Disseminated Sclerosis

An older name for multiple sclerosis, an immune-mediated disease in which areas of damage develop in the brain, spinal cord, or optic nerves and cause symptoms that vary over time.

Disseminated Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis that has spread through the bloodstream or lymphatic system to multiple organs. It may cause fever, weight loss, fatigue, organ damage, meningitis, or widespread small lesions.

Disseminated Varicella Infection

Chickenpox infection that spreads beyond the skin and may involve the lungs, brain, liver, or other organs. It is more likely and more severe in adults, pregnant people, and those with weakened immunity.

Disseminated Zoster

A severe, widespread reactivation of varicella-zoster virus characterized by greater than 20 cutaneous vesicles outside the primary and adjacent dermatomes, occurring predominantly in immunocompromised individuals and carrying a high risk of visceral organ dissemination (pneumonitis, encephalitis, hepatitis).

Dissociation

A disruption in the usual connection between consciousness, memory, identity, emotions, perceptions, behavior, or sense of self. Mild forms may occur during daydreaming; severe or persistent forms can

impair daily life.

Dissociative Amnesia

Inability to recall important autobiographical information, often related to trauma or severe stress, beyond ordinary forgetfulness. Memory loss may involve a specific event, period, or broader part of a person's life and is not better explained by ordinary forgetting, substances, a neurologic disorder, or another medical condition.

Dissociative Disorder

A psychiatric disorder characterized by a disruption in the normal, integrated functioning of consciousness, memory, identity, emotion, perception, body representation, motor control, or behavior. Typically developing as a profound psychological defense mechanism in response to overwhelming, severe childhood trauma or chronic abuse. Major DSM-5 categories include dissociative identity disorder (DID, presence of two or more distinct personality states or experiences of possession), dissociative amnesia (inability to recall important autobiographical information, usually of a traumatic or stressful nature, with or without dissociative fugue), and depersonalization/derealization disorder (persistent or recurrent experiences of unreality or detachment from one's mind/body or surroundings, with intact reality testing).

Alternate Names:
Dissociative Disorders

Dissociative Disorders

Plural form; see *Dissociative Disorder*.

Dissociative Identity Disorder

A mental health disorder involving two or more distinct identity states and repeated gaps in memory for everyday events or personal information. It can cause changes in behavior, emotions, perception, and daily functioning.

Distal

Farther from the point where a body part attaches or begins, or farther from the center of the body. For example, the hand is distal to the elbow.

Distal Convoluted Tubule

The segment of the renal nephron located between the macula densa and the cortical collecting duct, responsible for calcium reabsorption under parathyroid hormone regulation and thiazide-sensitive sodium-chloride cotransport.

Alternate Names:
DCT

Distal Median Nerve Dysfunction

Abnormal function of the median nerve near the forearm, wrist, or hand, causing numbness, tingling, pain, or weakness in its area of supply. Compression at the wrist is a common cause.

Distal Pancreatectomy

Surgery removing the body or tail of the pancreas, usually while leaving the head. It may be used for selected tumors, cysts, injury, or inflammation; diabetes and leakage from the pancreas are possible risks.

Distal Radius Fractures

Breaks near the wrist end of the forearm bone, often after a fall. They may cause pain, swelling, deformity, or numbness; treatment depends on alignment, joint involvement, bone quality, and nerve or blood-vessel injury.

Distal Renal Tubular Acidosis

A kidney disorder in which the kidneys cannot remove enough acid into the urine. Acid builds up in the blood and may cause low potassium, kidney stones, weak bones, muscle weakness, or poor growth in children.

Distal Splenorenal Shunt

Surgery connecting the splenic vein to the left kidney vein to lower pressure in veins around the esophagus. It may reduce bleeding from varices while preserving some blood flow through the liver.

Distal Tubule

A small kidney tube that adjusts the amount of salt, calcium, and water left in forming urine. Its activity

helps regulate blood pressure and body chemistry and can be affected by some diuretic medicines.

Distamycins

A group of antibiotic-like compounds that bind to DNA and have been studied for antimicrobial or anticancer effects. Their clinical use is limited and depends on the specific compound and evidence.

Distant

Far from a reference point or original site. In cancer, distant disease means that cancer has spread to remote organs or lymph nodes rather than remaining near the primary tumor.

Distended

Abnormally stretched, swollen, or enlarged by gas, fluid, blood, tissue, or pressure. The term may describe the abdomen, bladder, stomach, bowel, veins, or another body structure.

Distension

Enlargement or stretching of a body part or hollow organ, often from gas, fluid, urine, stool, blood, pressure, or blockage. Abdominal distension may occur with severe pain, vomiting, fever, or inability to pass stool or gas.

Distention

Enlargement or stretching of an organ, cavity, or body part, such as abdominal distention from gas, fluid, swelling, or blockage.

Distichia

Growth of an extra row of eyelashes, usually from openings of glands along the eyelid. Misguided lashes may rub the eye and cause irritation, tearing, corneal scratches, or ulcers.

Distortion

An abnormal change in the shape, structure, appearance, or representation of tissue or an image. New breast, facial, or visual distortion may indicate disease.

Distraction Osteogenesis

A surgical method for growing new bone by slowly separating two bone sections after a controlled cut. A device gradually widens the gap to lengthen or reshape the jaw, limbs, or other bones.

Distress

Significant physical or emotional suffering, discomfort, or strain related to illness, injury, treatment, or difficult circumstances. Severe distress may affect sleep, functioning, decisions, or safety and may need support.

Distributive Shock

Shock caused by marked vasodilation and abnormal distribution of blood flow, producing low systemic vascular resistance and inadequate effective tissue perfusion despite normal or high cardiac output early in the course. Sepsis, anaphylaxis, neurogenic shock, and some toxins are causes; skin may be warm initially, with hypotension, tachycardia or bradycardia, altered mentation, oliguria, and rising lactate.

District Nurse

A community nurse who provides care in homes, clinics, or other local settings. Duties may include wound care, chronic-disease support, health education, medicine monitoring, prevention, and coordination with other services.

Disulfiram-Like Reaction

An unpleasant reaction after alcohol is taken with disulfiram or another interacting substance. Flushing, headache, nausea, vomiting, palpitations, chest discomfort, or low blood pressure may occur.

Disulfiram Toxicity

Poisoning from excessive disulfiram, which may cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, drowsiness, confusion, hypotension, seizures, coma, peripheral neuropathy, or liver injury. A separate disulfiram–alcohol reaction causes flushing, throbbing headache, vomiting, tachycardia, and hypotension.

Disulfoton

A highly toxic organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, muscle weakness, breathing failure, seizures, or coma.

Dithiolethione

A sulfur-containing compound studied for activating cellular defense and detoxification pathways. It may influence inflammation and protection from chemical injury, but clinical uses depend on evidence for the specific compound.

Ditiocarb

A term for dithiocarbamate compounds, some of which are used as pesticides or metal-binding chemicals. Toxic effects vary by compound and may involve the nervous system, liver, kidneys, or skin.

Diuresis

Increased production of urine. It may result from excess fluid, high blood glucose, diabetes insipidus, medicines called diuretics, or other causes; excessive loss can lead to dehydration and electrolyte problems.

Diuretic

A medicine that makes the kidneys remove more salt and water in urine. It is used to treat high blood pressure, heart failure, or swelling caused by extra fluid in the body. Some types can change the body's salt levels and cause other side effects.

Diuretic Drug

A medicine that makes the kidneys remove more sodium and water in urine. It is used for high blood pressure, heart failure, and swelling but can cause dehydration, low blood pressure, electrolyte changes, or kidney problems.

Diuretic Resistance

A clinical failure to achieve expected therapeutic natriuresis, fluid excretion, and decongestion despite escalating doses of loop diuretics, commonly encountered in decompensated heart failure, nephrotic syndrome, and cirrhosis with refractory ascites.

Diurnal

Relating to daytime or occurring during a daily 24-hour cycle. The term may describe symptoms, hormone levels, body functions, or patterns of activity and sleep.

Diverticula

Alternate name; see *Diverticulosis*.

Diverticular Bleeding

Sudden, typically painless bleeding from the lower digestive tract caused by the bursting or erosion of a small blood vessel inside a diverticulum (a small pouch in the colon wall). It is one of the most common causes of significant bright red or dark maroon blood in the stool in older adults, often stopping on its own but occasionally causing significant blood loss.

Alternate Names:
Diverticular Hemorrhage

Diverticular Disease

A condition involving small pouches in the wall of the colon. Diverticulosis means the pouches are present, while diverticular disease generally refers to symptoms or complications such as abdominal pain, altered bowel habits, bleeding, inflammation, infection, blockage, or perforation. Diverticulitis is inflammation or infection of one or more pouches and commonly causes lower-abdominal pain and fever.

Diverticulitis

Inflammation or infection of one or more small pouches (diverticula) that bulge outward from the wall of the large intestine (colon). It occurs when a pouch becomes obstructed, leading to swelling, bacterial infection, or a tiny perforation in the intestinal wall. Symptoms typically include sudden, persistent pain in the lower left side of the abdomen, fever, nausea, vomiting, and changes in bowel habits.

Diverticulosis

The presence of small pouches in the wall of the colon. Most people have no symptoms. The pouches can sometimes bleed; inflammation of one or more

pouches is called diverticulitis.

Alternate Names:
Colonic Diverticulosis; Diverticular Pouching

Diverticulosis And Diverticulitis

Diverticulosis means small pouches have formed in the colon wall. Diverticulitis occurs when one or more pouches become inflamed or infected, causing abdominal pain, fever, and bowel changes.

Diverticulum

A pouch-like projection from the wall of a hollow organ, especially the intestine. It may cause no symptoms or become inflamed, infected, blocked, bleed, or rarely perforate.

Dix-Hallpike Maneuver

A bedside test for a common inner-ear cause of brief positional vertigo. The clinician moves the head and body into a specific position and watches for dizziness and characteristic eye movements.

Dizygotic Twin

One of a pair of non-identical (fraternal) twins resulting from the fertilization of two independent ova by two separate spermatozoa during the same ovulatory cycle. Dizygotic twins are genetically equivalent to full siblings, sharing on average 50% of their segregating genes, and can be of the same or different chromosomal sex. Characterized placentally by separate chorionic and amniotic sacs (dichorionic-diamniotic), although their placentas may fuse anatomically if implantation sites are adjacent. Influenced strongly by maternal age, family history, race, and assisted reproductive technologies.

Dizygotic Twins

Plural form; see *Dizygotic Twin*.

Dizziness

A sensation of spinning, lightheadedness, imbalance, faintness, or being unsteady. Causes include inner-ear, heart, blood-pressure, vision, medicine, blood, metabolic, or neurologic problems.

Dizzy

Alternate name; see *Dizziness*.

DKD

Abbreviation for diabetic kidney disease; see *Diabetic Kidney Disease*.

D-Lactic Acidosis

A rare metabolic encephalopathy and high anion gap metabolic acidosis occurring in patients with short bowel syndrome, resulting from colonic bacterial fermentation of unabsorbed carbohydrates into the D-isomer of lactic acid, which humans metabolize slowly.

Alternate Names:
D-Lactate Encephalopathy

DLCO

A lung-function test that measures how well a small amount of carbon monoxide passes from the lungs into the blood. A low result may occur in lung or blood-vessel disease and is interpreted with other test results.

Alternate Names:
Transfer Factor for Carbon Monoxide; TLCO

DLI

Donor lymphocyte infusion, in which immune cells from a stem-cell donor are given after transplantation to strengthen an immune attack against returning cancer. It can cause graft-versus-host disease and other complications.

DM

An abbreviation most commonly meaning diabetes mellitus, a group of disorders with persistently high blood glucose. Because DM can have other meanings, the surrounding clinical context is important.

DM2

An abbreviation for type 2 diabetes mellitus, in which the body resists insulin and may gradually produce too little of it. It can cause long-term damage to the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, and blood vessels.

DMD

Abbreviation for Duchenne muscular dystrophy, an X-linked muscle disease caused by deficient dystrophin. It usually begins in childhood with progressive proximal weakness, difficulty running or climbing, calf enlargement, and later heart and respiratory complications.

DMFT Index

A dental measure counting permanent teeth that are decayed, missing because of decay, or filled. It estimates a person's lifetime experience of tooth decay but does not show whether a current problem is active.

DMG

Alternate name; see *Diffuse Midline Glioma*.

DMSA Scan

A nuclear-imaging test using a small amount of labeled dimercaptosuccinic acid to show kidney tissue. It can identify differences in kidney function, scars, or injury, especially in children with repeated urinary infections.

DNA

Deoxyribonucleic acid, the molecule that stores hereditary information in humans and most organisms. Its sequence helps control cell function and protein production; changes may be inherited or acquired during life.

DNA Adduct

A chemical group attached to DNA after exposure to a reactive substance. If not repaired, it can alter DNA copying, cause mutations, and potentially contribute to cancer.

DNA Alkylation

Attachment of an alkyl group to DNA. This can change base pairing, block copying or repair, cause mutations, or kill a cell; some anticancer medicines work partly this way.

DNA Amplification

Production of many copies of a selected DNA sequence, naturally in cells or in the laboratory by methods such as polymerase chain reaction. It helps detect, identify, or study genes and microorganisms.

DNA Binding

Attachment of a protein or other molecule to a DNA sequence. This can control gene activity, DNA copying, repair, chromosome organization, or the action of some medicines.

DNA Damage

A chemical or structural change in DNA that can interfere with gene function or copying. Cells usually repair such damage, but persistent or incorrectly repaired damage can cause mutations, cell death, or cancer.

DNA Demethylation

Removal or loss of small chemical groups called methyl groups from DNA. It can change how accessible a gene is and alter gene activity during development, cell reprogramming, or disease.

DNA Double Helix

The twisted ladder-like structure of DNA, formed by two strands running in opposite directions. Sugar and phosphate form the outside rails, while paired bases join the strands inside.

DNA Fragmentation

Breaking DNA strands into smaller pieces. It occurs normally during programmed cell death and can also result from injury, radiation, chemicals, disease, or laboratory processing.

DNA Gyrase

A bacterial enzyme that twists and untwists DNA so it can be copied and separated. Fluoroquinolone antibiotics block this enzyme, stopping bacterial growth and survival.

DNA Helicase

An essential adenosine triphosphate-dependent mo-

tor enzyme that unwinds and separates double-stranded DNA into single strands ahead of the replication fork, enabling DNA polymerases access for replication, transcription, and recombination.

DNA Integration

Insertion of foreign or copied DNA into a cell's genome. It occurs in some viral infections, evolution, and gene therapy and can alter nearby gene activity if the insertion affects a control region.

DNA Ligases

Enzymes that join breaks in DNA strands during copying, repair, and genetic recombination. They help preserve the continuous structure of chromosomes.

DNA Ligation

Joining DNA fragments by forming a chemical bond between them. Cells use it during DNA copying and repair, and laboratories use it in genetic testing and cloning.

DNA Methylation

Addition of small chemical groups called methyl groups to DNA, usually at cytosine bases. It can change how strongly a gene is expressed without changing the DNA sequence.

DNA Packaging

Arrangement of long DNA molecules around histone proteins and into compact structures called chromosomes. Packaging allows DNA to fit inside the nucleus and helps control access to genes.

DNA Polymerase

A family of cellular enzymes that synthesize new DNA strands by polymerizing deoxynucleotides complementary to a single-stranded template in a 5-prime to 3-prime direction, with many isoforms possessing 3-prime to 5-prime exonucleolytic proofreading activity.

DNA Primase

An enzyme that makes short RNA starting pieces so other enzymes can begin copying DNA. It is required during cell division and DNA repair.

DNA Primers

Short nucleic-acid sequences that provide a starting point for copying DNA. Cells make them during replication, and laboratories use designed primers to amplify selected genetic sequences.

DNA Probe

A labeled single-stranded DNA sequence designed to bind a matching target. It can help detect a gene, mutation, chromosome region, or microorganism in a laboratory sample.

DNA Profiling

A laboratory test that compares selected parts of a person's DNA. It can help identify a person, assess biological relationships, identify remains, or check whether cells came from a donor or another person. Results depend on sample quality, testing method, and legal or medical setting.

Alternate Names:
Fingerprinting; Genetic Fingerprinting; DNA Typing; STR Analysis

DNA Repair

Cellular processes that detect and correct damage or copying errors in DNA. Repair pathways address small base changes, bulky chemical damage, mismatched bases, and breaks in one or both DNA strands.

DNA Repair Mechanisms

Cellular systems that correct DNA damage caused by copying errors, chemicals, radiation, or reactive oxygen. Failure of some pathways increases mutation risk and can contribute to inherited cancer syndromes.

DNA Replication

The process by which DNA copies itself before cell division. Each new DNA molecule contains one original strand and one newly made strand, allowing genetic information to pass to daughter cells.

DNA Sequencing

Determination of the order of DNA building blocks in a sample. It can examine a single gene, selected genes, all coding regions, or the whole genome to identify genetic changes.

DNA Virus

A virus whose genetic material is DNA. DNA viruses vary widely in transmission, tissues affected, and disease; some cause persistent infection, while others cause short-term illness.

D.O.

Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine, a physician degree whose graduates are licensed to practice medicine and surgery like MD graduates in the United States.

DOAC Monotherapy

Use of a direct oral anticoagulant (DOAC) without concomitant antiplatelet therapy, such as aspirin or clopidogrel.

Alternate Names:
NOAC Monotherapy

DOACs

Direct oral anticoagulants are oral blood thinners that directly block thrombin or factor Xa. They prevent and treat blood clots but can cause bleeding and require attention to kidney function, interactions, and planned procedures.

DOB

An abbreviation for date of birth, the day, month, and year a person was born. It helps confirm identity and calculate age for records, screening, medicine doses, and treatment decisions.

Dobutamine

An intravenous medicine that increases heart contraction and, sometimes, heart rate. It is used short term for selected cases of severe low-output heart failure or shock and requires close monitoring.

Dobutamine Stress Echocardiography

An ultrasound heart test using dobutamine to increase heart workload when a person cannot exercise adequately. New areas of poor wall movement may suggest reduced blood flow; findings are considered with other clinical information.

Doc

Informal shorthand for doctor, a person qualified to practice medicine or another health profession. The exact role depends on the person's training and professional license.

Docetaxel

An anticancer medicine that interferes with microtubules, structures needed for cell division. It is used for several cancers and can cause low blood counts, infection, hair loss, nerve problems, or allergic reactions.

Alternate Names:
Taxotere

Doconexent

A pharmaceutical name for docosahexaenoic acid, an omega-3 fatty acid found in oily fish, algae, and cell membranes. Its effects depend on the product, dose, and reason for use.

Docosadienoic Acid

A 22-carbon fatty acid with two double bonds, present in small amounts in body and dietary lipids. It is studied mainly for possible effects on cell membranes and metabolism.

Docosahexaenoic Acid

An omega-3 fatty acid that is an important structural part of brain and retinal cell membranes. It comes mainly from oily fish, algae, or supplements and is especially important during brain development.

Docosapentaenoic Acid

A 22-carbon polyunsaturated fatty acid with five double bonds. It occurs as omega-3 and omega-6 forms in foods and tissues; its health effects depend on the form and amount.

Docosatrienoic Acid

A 22-carbon fatty acid with three double bonds, found in small amounts in body and dietary lipids. It is studied mainly for its possible roles in cell membranes and metabolism.

Docusate

A stool-softening medicine that helps water mix with stool. It may be used when avoiding straining is important, but evidence for treating ordinary constipation is limited; diarrhea and abdominal cramps can occur.

Dog Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins from a dog's skin flakes, saliva, urine, or other secretions. It can cause sneezing, blocked or itchy nose, watery eyes, hives, cough, or asthma symptoms.

Dog Bite

An injury caused by a dog's teeth. It can cause puncture wounds, tissue damage, infection, and exposure to rabies or tetanus, especially when deep or involving the face or hand.

Alternate Names:
Canine Bite Trauma; Dog Bite Wound

Dolasetron

A medicine that blocks serotonin 5-HT3 receptors and helps prevent nausea and vomiting in selected settings. It can cause headache, constipation, or dangerous heart-rhythm changes.

Dolasetron Mesylate

Alternate name; see *Dolasetron*.

Dolichocephalic

Having a relatively long, narrow skull. It may be a normal family or positional variation, but marked or worsening skull narrowing in an infant may indicate early fusion of a skull suture.

Dolichol

A long-chain fatty alcohol used inside cells to assemble sugar chains attached to proteins. This process is important for protein folding, transport, and function.

Dolichostenomelia

Abnormally long, slender limbs, often used to describe a marfanoid body habitus. It may occur in connective-tissue disorders such as Marfan syndrome and can occur with other skeletal and cardiovascular features.

Doll Eye Reflex

The oculocephalic reflex in which rapid passive rotation or flexion and extension of the head in an unconscious or comatose patient produces conjugately opposed compensatory eye movements when the brainstem pathways linking cranial nerves III, VI, and VIII through the medial longitudinal fasciculus are functionally intact.

Alternate Names:
Oculocephalic Reflex; Doll's Eyes Phenomenon

Doll's Eye Sign

A physical examination finding of the oculocephalic reflex in comatose patients, in which rapid horizontal or vertical rotation of the head produces conjugate eye deviation in the direction opposite to head movement, demonstrating intact midbrain and pontine brainstem pathways.

Alternate Names:
Oculocephalic Reflex

Dolor

The Latin word for pain, one of the classic signs of inflammation. Pain may result from irritated nerves, swelling, injury, infection, or another cause and is interpreted with other findings.

Domain

A defined region or area. In biology, a protein domain is a part with a particular structure or function; in genetics, a domain may be a genomic or regulatory region.

Domestic Violence

A pattern of physical, sexual, emotional, psycho-

logical, or financial abuse or coercive control by an intimate partner or household member. It can cause injury, fear, isolation, and serious health effects; confidential support is available.

Dominant

Describing a genetic variant whose effect can appear when only one copy is present. An affected parent with an autosomal dominant condition may pass the variant to each child with a one-in-two chance.

Domperidone

A medicine that blocks dopamine receptors outside the brain and is used in some countries for nausea or slow stomach movement. It can prolong the heart rhythm and cause dangerous arrhythmias.

Donath-Landsteiner Antibody

An antibody that can attach to red blood cells in cold conditions and destroy them when the blood warms. It is associated with paroxysmal cold hemoglobinuria, a rare cause of red-cell breakdown.

Alternate Names:
Donath-Landsteiner Hemolysin; Biphasic Hemolysin

Donath-Landsteiner Test

A blood test that detects an antibody associated with paroxysmal cold hemoglobinuria. The antibody binds red cells in the cold and destroys them when the blood warms.

Donepezil

A medicine that increases acetylcholine activity in the brain and may temporarily improve symptoms of Alzheimer disease. It does not cure the disease and can cause nausea, diarrhea, slow heartbeat, fainting, or sleep problems.

Donnan Equilibrium

The distribution of charged particles across a partly permeable membrane when large charged particles cannot cross. It helps explain cell volume, membrane electrical charge, and movement of salts and water.

Donohue Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot respond normally to insulin. It causes severe growth and feeding problems, very little body fat, unusual facial features, and serious metabolic complications beginning in infancy.

Donor

A person who provides blood, cells, tissue, an organ, sperm, eggs, or another biological material for another person or for research. Screening, informed consent, compatibility, and traceability support safety.

Donor Insemination

A fertility treatment in which sperm from a screened donor is placed in the reproductive tract to attempt pregnancy. The donor may be known or anonymous, and counseling and legal requirements vary by location.

Donor Suitability Assessment

Evaluation of a potential donor's medical history, examination, laboratory tests, infection risks, organ function, and compatibility to determine whether donation is safe and suitable for transplantation.

Donor Testing

Laboratory and clinical evaluation of a potential donor for infections, cancer, organ function, blood type, and other factors that affect donation safety and recipient compatibility.

Do Not Resuscitate

Alternate name; see *Do-Not-Resuscitate Order*.

Do-Not-Resuscitate Order

A medical order instructing clinicians not to perform cardiopulmonary resuscitation if a person's breathing or heartbeat stops. It does not automatically refuse other treatments or comfort care.

Alternate Names:
DNR Order; DNAR Order; Allow Natural Death (AND)

Donovan Bodies

Intracellular clusters of deeply staining, encapsulated, pleomorphic gram-negative rod bacteria (Klebsiella granulomatis) located within the cytoplasm of large mononuclear histiocytes, identified on Giemsa or Wright-stained tissue smears from lesions of granuloma inguinale (donovanosis).

Alternate Names:
Donovan Body; Leishmanoid Granules

Donovanosis

A sexually transmitted infection caused by Klebsiella granulomatis. It produces slowly enlarging, usually painless genital ulcers that may bleed easily; diagnosis uses laboratory testing and treatment uses antibiotics.

Alternate Names:
Granuloma Inguinale; Calymmatobacterium Infection

Dopa

A chemical precursor that the body can convert into dopamine. Levodopa, a form that reaches the brain, is used with another medicine to improve movement problems in Parkinson disease.

Dopamine

A chemical messenger made by nerve cells and some hormone-producing cells. In the brain, it helps control movement, attention, motivation, and learning. It also affects blood-vessel width and limits the release of prolactin, a hormone that helps the body make breast milk.

Dopamine Agonist

A medication that stimulates dopamine receptors in the brain by mimicking the actions of dopamine, a natural chemical messenger that regulates movement and emotions. These medications are used to help control tremors, stiffness, and slow movement in conditions such as Parkinson disease, to reduce the urge to move the legs in restless legs syndrome, or to shrink certain pituitary tumors.

Dopamine Agonists

Plural form; see *Dopamine Agonist*.

Dopamine Antagonist

A medicine or compound that blocks dopamine receptors. It is used in selected psychiatric, nausea, or digestive treatments but can cause movement problems, drowsiness, hormone changes, or other adverse effects.

Dopamine Receptor

A protein on or inside a cell that responds to dopamine. Different receptor types affect movement, mood, hormone release, blood vessels, and other functions and are targets of some medicines.

Dopaminergic Neuron

A nerve cell that makes and releases dopamine. These cells help control movement, motivation, reward, attention, and hormone regulation; loss of some contributes to Parkinson disease.

Dopaminergic Pathways

Four main nerve pathways that use dopamine to send signals. They help control movement, reward, thinking, emotions, and the release of some hormones.

Dopamine Transporter

A protein that clears dopamine from the space between nerve cells by moving it back into the releasing nerve cell. Stimulants and some imaging tracers affect or measure its activity.

Dopa-Responsive Dystonia

An inherited movement disorder causing sustained muscle contractions and abnormal postures, sometimes with Parkinson-like symptoms. It often improves markedly with a small dose of levodopa.

Doppler Echocardiography

A heart ultrasound technique that measures the direction and speed of blood flow through the heart and major vessels. It helps assess valves, chambers, pressure, and abnormal flow.

Doppler Ultrasound

An ultrasound technique that measures moving

blood to assess its direction and speed. It can identify narrowed or blocked vessels, abnormal flow, blood clots, and circulation problems without ionizing radiation.

Doppler Ultrasound of a Limb

An ultrasound examination measuring blood flow through the arteries and veins of an arm or leg. It can help identify narrowing, blockage, a clot, aneurysm, or other circulation problem without ionizing radiation.

Doppler Velocimetry

Ultrasound measurement of blood-flow speed and resistance in fetal or placental vessels. It helps assess circulation and fetal well-being when poor growth, placental problems, or other pregnancy risks are suspected.

Doravirine

An HIV medicine that blocks reverse transcriptase, an enzyme HIV needs to copy its genetic material. It is used with other medicines for HIV-1 infection; interactions and resistance affect its choice.

Dorea

A group of bacteria commonly found in the human intestine and able to grow without oxygen. Finding it usually reflects normal gut organisms unless it comes from a normally sterile site with compatible illness.

Doripenem

An intravenous antibiotic that damages bacterial cell walls and is used for selected serious infections. It can cause allergy, diarrhea, or seizures; bacterial resistance can affect its activity.

Dormant

Inactive or not multiplying. The term may describe a latent infection, quiet tumor cell, inactive disease process, or other biological state that can become active under certain conditions.

Dor Procedure

A heart operation that removes or excludes a scarred, bulging part of the left ventricle after a large heart attack. It reshapes the chamber in selected people with severe ischemic heart-muscle disease.

Alternate Names:
Endoventricular Circular Patch Plasty (EVCPP); Surgical Ventricular Restoration

Dorsal

Relating to the back of the body or the back-facing surface of a body part. On the hand, dorsal means the side opposite the palm; on the foot, it means the top surface opposite the sole. In other parts of the body, it usually means toward the back.

Dorsal Blocking Splint

A hand splint that limits wrist and finger extension to protect healing tendons, commonly after flexor-tendon repair. Position and duration are set by the treating surgical and therapy team.

Dorsal Body Cavity

The body cavity toward the back. It includes the cranial cavity, which contains the brain, and the spinal cavity, which contains the spinal cord.

Dorsal Column-Medial Lemniscal Pathway

The major ascending sensory pathway conveying conscious proprioception, discriminative fine touch, and vibratory sensation from peripheral mechanoreceptors through the spinal cord fasciculus gracilis and cuneatus to the medulla, where fibers decussate in the medial lemniscus to ascend to the thalamus.

Alternate Names:
DCML Pathway; Dorsal Column System

Dorsal Funiculus

A back column of the spinal cord containing nerve fibers that carry vibration, fine touch, and awareness of body position to the brain.

Dorsalis Pedis Artery

An artery running across the top of the foot as a

continuation of the anterior tibial artery. Its pulse helps assess blood flow to the foot.

Dorsal Kyphosis

Excessive forward curvature of the upper spine, causing a rounded upper back. It may result from posture, spinal wear, osteoporosis, or vertebral fractures and can cause pain, height loss, or breathing difficulty.

Dorsal Root

The back root of a spinal nerve. It carries sensory signals from the body into the spinal cord.

Dorsal Root Ganglion

A swelling on the back root of a spinal nerve containing the cell bodies of sensory nerve cells. It relays information about touch, pain, temperature, and body position to the spinal cord.

Dorsiflexion

Upward movement of the foot at the ankle, bringing the toes toward the shin. It helps clear the foot during walking; weakness can cause foot drop and tripping.

Dorsocervical Fat Pad

A visible accumulation of fat at the back of the neck and upper shoulders, associated with obesity, corticosteroid excess, some medicines, or lipodystrophy; it differs from spinal kyphosis.

Dorsolateral

Describing a position toward the back and side of a body structure. For example, a dorsolateral area is behind and to one side rather than toward the front or middle.

Dorsum

The back or upper surface of a body part, such as the back of the hand, top of the foot, or upper surface of the tongue.

Dorzolamide

An eye medicine that lowers pressure inside the eye by reducing fluid production. It is used for glaucoma or raised eye pressure and may cause stinging, blurred vision, or a bitter taste.

Dosage

The amount, frequency, route, and duration of a medicine given to achieve benefit while limiting harm. It may need adjustment for age, weight, kidney or liver function, interactions, and the condition treated.

Dosage Forms

The physical form in which a medicine is supplied, such as a tablet, capsule, liquid, cream, inhaler, injection, patch, suppository, or implant. The form affects how and how quickly it is given.

Dose

The amount of a medicine, radiation, or other substance given or received at one time. The appropriate dose depends on the substance, purpose, age, weight, organ function, interactions, and individual risk.

Dose-Limiting Toxicity

A treatment-related adverse effect severe enough to prevent increasing the dose or require reducing it. The term is used especially in early cancer trials to estimate a tolerable dose.

Dose Rate

The amount of a medicine, radiation, or other exposure delivered during a specified time, such as milligrams per hour or grays per minute. It affects both benefit and toxicity.

Dose-Response Curve

A graph showing how the size of a biological effect changes as the dose of a medicine or substance increases. It helps describe potency, maximum effect, and the dose range that produces benefit or harm.

Dose-Response Relationship

The relationship between the amount of a medicine or substance and the size of its effect. Increasing

the dose may increase benefit, toxicity, or both, but the pattern depends on the substance and person.

Dose Titration

Gradual adjustment of a medicine dose according to its effects, treatment goals, blood tests, or side effects. The dose may be increased, decreased, or kept the same as the person's response is assessed.

Dosimeter

An instrument worn or placed near a person or object to measure or record exposure to ionizing radiation. It helps monitor occupational or treatment-related radiation.

Dosimetry

Measurement and calculation of radiation dose received by a person, tissue, or object. In treatment, it helps plan and verify that the intended dose reaches the target while limiting exposure elsewhere.

DOTATATE

A substance that binds somatostatin receptors found on many neuroendocrine tumors. When linked to a radioactive tracer, it is used in PET imaging to locate and stage tumors and assess possible targeted treatment.

DOTS

A tuberculosis-control strategy involving reliable diagnosis, standardized combination treatment, medicine-supply support, monitoring, and sometimes directly observed doses. It aims to cure infection and limit drug resistance and transmission.

Double Aortic Arch

A birth defect in which two aortic arches form a ring around the windpipe and esophagus. It may cause noisy breathing, cough, feeding difficulty, vomiting, or trouble swallowing.

Double-Balloon Enteroscopy

An endoscopic procedure using two balloons to move a flexible camera through much of the small intestine. It can locate bleeding or lesions, take biopsies, and perform selected treatments.

Double Blind

Alternate name; see *Double-Blind Study*.

Double-Blind Method

Alternate name; see *Double-Blind Study*.

Double-Blind Study

A clinical study in which participants and the investigators assessing outcomes do not know the assigned treatment group during the blinded phase. This masking reduces bias from expectations and assessment; the term does not specify who else may know the assignments.

Alternate Names:
Double-Masked Study; Double-Blind Protocol

Double Blind Trial

Alternate name; see *Double-Blind Study*.

Double Bubble Sign

An imaging finding in a newborn showing two enlarged, air- or fluid-filled areas representing the stomach and first part of the small intestine. It strongly suggests a blockage near the start of the small intestine, such as duodenal atresia, but other causes are possible.

Alternate Names:
Duodenal Atresia Sign; Double Bubble Radiographic Appearance

Double-Contrast Barium Enema

An X-ray examination in which barium coats the inside of the colon and air expands it. It can show polyps, masses, narrowing, or changes in the bowel lining.

Alternate Names:
Air-Contrast Barium Enema

Double Inlet Left Ventricle

A rare birth defect in which both upper heart chambers connect mainly to one lower chamber. It produces single-ventricle circulation and mixing of oxygen-rich and oxygen-poor blood and usually

needs staged specialist treatment.

Double Outlet Right Ventricle

A birth defect in which both major arteries arise mainly from the right lower heart chamber. An opening between the lower chambers allows blood from the left chamber to reach the arteries; anatomy and symptoms vary.

Double-Outlet Right Ventricle

Alternate spelling; see *Double Outlet Right Ventricle*.

Double Uterus

A birth difference in which the uterus develops as two separate cavities or two uteruses. Some people have no symptoms; others may have menstrual problems, infertility, miscarriage, or pregnancy complications.

Double Vision

Seeing two images of one object. Causes include eye-surface or lens disease, eye misalignment, muscle or nerve problems, medicines, migraine, or brain disease; sudden onset with neurologic symptoms or eye pain is an emergency.

Douche

A stream of water or solution directed into a body cavity, most often the vagina. Vaginal douching can irritate tissue, disturb normal bacteria, and increase infection risk.

Dowager Hump

An exaggerated posterior thoracic hyperkyphosis causing an abnormal dorsal hump at the base of the neck, caused by multiple anterior wedge compression fractures of osteoporotic thoracic vertebral bodies in elderly patients.

Alternate Names:
Senile Kyphosis; Postmenopausal Thoracic Hyperkyphosis

Dowager's Hump

Alternate name; see *Dowager Hump*.

Dowling-Meara Syndrome

A severe inherited form of epidermolysis bullosa simplex, usually caused by variants in the *KRT5* or *KRT14* gene. Widespread grouped blisters may begin at birth or in infancy and can affect the skin, mouth, nails, and airway.

Alternate Names:
Epidermolysis Bullosa Simplex, Dowling-Meara Type; EBS-DM

Downregulation

A decrease in the number, sensitivity, or activity of receptors, genes, or signaling pathways. It may occur after prolonged stimulation, medicine exposure, inflammation, or another regulatory change.

Down Syndrome

A genetic condition caused by the presence of an extra copy of chromosome 21 (trisomy 21). This extra genetic material alters the course of physical and mental development. Common characteristics include distinct facial features (such as upward slanting eyes and a flattened facial profile), mild to moderate intellectual disability, low muscle tone in infancy, and higher risks of congenital heart defects, hearing loss, and thyroid disorders.

Alternate Names:
Trisomy 21; Down's Syndrome

Doxapram

A medicine that stimulates breathing and is used rarely in selected situations. It can cause agitation, high blood pressure, fast or abnormal heart rhythms, seizures, or other serious effects.

Doxazosin

An alpha-1 blocker that relaxes blood vessels and prostate or bladder-neck muscle. It is used for high blood pressure or urinary symptoms from an enlarged prostate and can cause dizziness or fainting.

Doxazosin Mesylate

A salt form of doxazosin, an alpha-1 blocker used for high blood pressure and urinary symptoms from an enlarged prostate. It can cause dizziness, low blood pressure, fainting, or falls, especially after the

first dose.

Doxepin

A tricyclic antidepressant also used in low doses for insomnia or skin itching. It can cause drowsiness, dry mouth, constipation, blurred vision, abnormal heart rhythms, and dangerous toxicity in overdose.

Doxepin Overdose

Taking too much doxepin can cause severe drowsiness, confusion, seizures, low blood pressure, coma, and life-threatening heart-rhythm or conduction problems, especially with alcohol or other medicines.

Doxercalciferol

A vitamin D-like medicine used in selected people with chronic kidney disease to reduce excess parathyroid hormone. It can raise calcium and phosphate levels.

Doxorubicin

An anthracycline cancer medicine that damages DNA and blocks cell division. It treats many cancers but can cause low blood counts, infection, nausea, hair loss, tissue injury after leakage, and dose-related heart damage.

Doxorubicin Hydrochloride

A salt form of doxorubicin, an anthracycline cancer medicine used for many cancers. Important risks include low blood counts, infection, tissue injury after leakage, and dose-related heart damage.

Doxycycline

A tetracycline antibiotic that blocks bacterial protein production. It treats many bacterial and tick-borne infections and can cause nausea, sun sensitivity, esophageal irritation, diarrhea, or tooth and bone effects in developing children.

Doxycycline Hyclate

A salt form of doxycycline, a tetracycline antibiotic that blocks bacterial protein production. It is used for susceptible infections; nausea, sun sensitivity, esophageal irritation, diarrhea, and allergic reactions may occur.

Doxylamine

A sedating antihistamine used in some sleep aids and pregnancy-related nausea treatments. It can cause drowsiness, dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, confusion, or impaired driving.

DPP-4 Inhibitor

An oral antihyperglycemic medication (e.g., sitagliptin, linagliptin, saxagliptin, alogliptin) that competitively inhibits the dipeptidyl peptidase-4 (DPP-4) enzyme. By preventing the rapid enzymatic degradation of endogenous incretin hormones—specifically glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) and glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide (GIP)—it potentiates glucose-dependent insulin secretion from pancreatic β-cells and suppresses inappropriate postprandial glucagon secretion from α-cells. Characterized by weight neutrality, once-daily oral dosing, and a negligible intrinsic risk of hypoglycemia in monotherapy.

DPP-4 Inhibitors

Plural form; see *DPP-4 Inhibitor*.

DPT Immunization

Older term for vaccination against diphtheria, pertussis (whooping cough), and tetanus. Current vaccines use formulations such as DTaP for young children and Tdap for older children and adults.

DR

Alternate name; see *Diabetic Retinopathy*.

Dracunculiasis

Guinea-worm disease caused by a parasite acquired from unsafe drinking water containing infected tiny water fleas. About a year later, a painful blister usually forms on a leg as the adult worm emerges through the skin.

Dracunculosis

Infection with the Guinea-worm parasite after drinking unsafe water containing infected water fleas. It

causes a painful blister, usually on a leg, followed by emergence of a long adult worm through the skin.

Dracunculus Medinensis

The parasitic worm that causes Guinea-worm disease. People become infected by drinking water containing tiny infected water fleas; roughly a year later, an adult female worm emerges through the skin.

Draf Procedure

One of several endoscopic operations that widen the drainage pathway of the frontal sinuses. Draf types I, IIa, IIb, and III differ in how much tissue is removed; type III, also called the modified Lothrop procedure, creates a shared opening between the two frontal sinuses.

Drain

A tube or other device used to remove blood, pus, fluid, or air from a wound, body cavity, or organ. Drainage may prevent pressure, infection, or impaired healing after injury or surgery.

Drainage

Removal of blood, pus, fluid, or air from a body site, wound, or abnormal collection. It may occur naturally or use a needle, catheter, tube, or surgical opening to relieve pressure and aid healing.

Drainage Procedures

Treatments that remove pus, blood, or other collected fluid, sometimes with ultrasound or CT guidance. They may use a needle, catheter, tube, or surgery to treat abscesses and other fluid collections.

Drain Opener Poisoning

Exposure to a caustic drain-cleaning product that can cause severe burns of the skin, eyes, airway, or gastrointestinal tract.

Drainpipe Cleaners

Strong chemical products used to clear blocked pipes, commonly containing caustic alkalis or acids. Swallowing, inhaling, or splashing these products can cause severe burns to the mouth, throat, eyes, skin, or lungs.

Drawer Test

An orthopedic manual examination of the flexed knee joint assessing the integrity of the cruciate ligaments; forward tibial translation tests the anterior cruciate ligament (anterior drawer test) and backward tibial translation tests the posterior cruciate ligament (posterior drawer test).

Alternate Names:
Knee Drawer Sign; Anterior and Posterior Drawer Tests

Dream

A succession of subjective cognitive, sensory, perceptual, and affective experiences occurring involuntarily in the mind during sleep states. While mentation can occur during non-rapid-eye-movement (NREM) sleep (typically more fragmented and thought-like), vivid, narratively structured, emotionally intense, and sensorially rich dreams occur predominantly during rapid-eye-movement (REM) sleep, corresponding neurophysiologically with limbic and paralimbic activation, forebrain cholinergic tone, and visual association cortex activity coupled with dorsolateral prefrontal cortical deactivation and somatic muscle atonia.

Dreams

Plural form; see *Dream*.

Drepanocytosis

Sickle-cell disease or a related condition in which an abnormal form of hemoglobin makes red blood cells become rigid and sickle-shaped. This can cause anemia, painful blockages of blood flow, and damage to organs.

Dressing

Material placed over a wound to protect it from contamination, absorb drainage, control minor bleeding, maintain moisture, or deliver local treatment. Change frequency and monitoring depend on the wound and dressing.

Dressler's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Dressler Syndrome*.

Dressler Syndrome

An immune-related inflammation of the sac around the heart that occurs weeks after a heart attack, heart surgery, or other heart injury. It can cause fever, sharp chest pain, and fluid around the heart or lungs.

DRESS Syndrome

A serious delayed allergic reaction to a medicine, usually beginning two to eight weeks after exposure. It may cause fever, widespread rash, facial swelling, abnormal blood counts, hepatitis, kidney injury, or other organ inflammation.

DRI

Dietary reference values used to estimate the amounts of vitamins, minerals, protein, and other nutrients needed by healthy people. They help assess diets but are not individualized treatment targets for every illness.

Alternate Names:
Dietary Reference Intakes

Dried Specimen

A biological sample collected and dried on a prepared card or other surface for transport and laboratory testing. Dried blood spots are commonly used for screening, but correct collection and handling are essential.

Drinking Water

Water safe for human consumption, with levels of disease-causing organisms and harmful chemicals low enough to avoid significant health risk. Boiling, filtration, chlorination, and bottled water are methods used to reduce contamination.

Drip

A drop-by-drop flow of liquid, or fluid given slowly into a vein through tubing and a catheter. The infusion rate is controlled to deliver medicines, fluids, blood products, or nutrients safely.

Driving And Older Adults

Evaluation of whether an older person can drive safely, considering vision, attention, memory, hearing, movement, health conditions, and medicines. Age alone does not determine driving ability.

Driving Evaluation

An assessment of driving ability after illness, injury, or a health change. It may examine vision, attention, memory, reaction time, strength, and vehicle control in a clinic and on the road; adaptive equipment may help.

Driving Rehabilitation

Assessment and training to help a person resume driving safely or use adaptive vehicle controls after illness or injury. It may address vision, attention, reaction time, strength, vehicle operation, and road safety.

Dronabinol

A medicine related to the active substance in cannabis, used for selected cases of chemotherapy-related nausea or severe appetite loss. It may cause dizziness, sleepiness, confusion, mood changes, or impaired coordination.

Drool

Saliva that unintentionally escapes from the mouth. It may result from excess saliva, difficulty swallowing, poor lip closure, dental problems, or a neurologic condition affecting mouth control.

Drooling

Unintentional loss of saliva from the mouth caused by excess saliva, difficulty swallowing, poor lip closure, or reduced control of the mouth. Persistent drooling may be associated with dental, medication, or neurologic causes.

Drooping Eyelids

Ptosis, or abnormal lowering of one or both upper eyelids. Causes include age-related tendon stretching, nerve or muscle disease, congenital weakness, trauma, or a mass; sudden ptosis with double vision, headache, or unequal pupils is urgent.

Drop Arm Test

A shoulder examination that helps assess for a substantial rotator-cuff tear, especially of the supraspinatus. The examiner passively raises the arm to about 90 degrees and asks the person to lower it slowly. Inability to hold the arm up or lower it smoothly is a positive result; a negative test does not rule out a tear.

Alternate Names:
Dropped Arm Test

Drop Attack

A descriptive term for a sudden fall or collapse, often without warning. It may happen with or without loss of consciousness and can result from fainting, a seizure, or a balance problem. The cause must be assessed because the event may not be a simple trip or slip.

Drop Attacks

Alternate plural name; see *Drop Attack*.

Droperidol

A medicine used in selected clinical settings to treat severe nausea or agitation. It can prolong the heart's electrical recovery time and rarely cause dangerous arrhythmias, so heart-risk factors and monitoring may be important.

Drop Foot

Alternate name; see *Foot Drop*.

Drop Hand Syndrome

Weakness or paralysis of the muscles that straighten the wrist and fingers, usually from injury or pressure on the radial nerve. The wrist hangs downward and gripping or releasing objects becomes difficult.

Droplet Precautions

Infection-control measures for infections spread by respiratory droplets released during coughing, sneezing, or talking. They may include a medical mask, hand hygiene, patient separation, and limiting transport according to the infection.

Dropper Bottle

A bottle with a device that releases liquid one drop at a time. Drop size varies with the liquid and device, affecting the amount delivered.

Drowning

Breathing impairment caused by submersion or immersion in liquid. It may be fatal or nonfatal. Lack of oxygen can injure the brain and other organs; complications include aspiration, lung injury, and respiratory failure.

Drowning Signs

Findings after respiratory impairment caused by submersion or immersion in liquid. They may include coughing, difficulty breathing, low blood oxygen, confusion, unconsciousness, or cardiac arrest; the findings depend on the severity and duration of oxygen deprivation. "Dry drowning," "wet drowning," and "secondary drowning" are nonstandard terms, not distinct diagnoses.

Drowsiness

An increased tendency to fall asleep or reduced alertness. It may result from too little sleep, medicines, alcohol or other substances, metabolic illness, sleep disorders, infection, or neurologic disease; sudden severe drowsiness can occur with acute illness.

Drug

A substance that changes body function or is used to prevent, diagnose, or treat disease. Drugs include prescription medicines, nonprescription medicines, biological products, and substances used recreationally or illegally.

Drug- and Nephrotoxin-Associated Kidney Disorders

Kidney injury caused by medicines, contrast agents, industrial chemicals, supplements, or other toxins. Patterns include acute tubular injury, interstitial nephritis, glomerular disease, crystals, obstruction, and chronic fibrosis; medication review and prompt withdrawal of a culprit may limit damage.

Drug Caution Code

A code used in a medicine record or labeling system to flag a risk such as allergy, drug interaction, dose restriction, or required monitoring. There is no universal drug-caution code; each code is defined by the system that uses it.

Drug Delivery

The way a medicine is prepared and given so its active ingredient reaches the intended body site at an effective dose. Routes include swallowing, inhalation, skin application, injection, implantation, and targeted systems.

Drug Desensitization

A supervised process that gives gradually increasing doses of a medicine to temporarily reduce an allergic reaction when that medicine is essential and no suitable alternative exists. The tolerance usually ends when doses are interrupted.

Drug Discovery

The process of finding and developing substances that may prevent, diagnose, or treat disease. It includes laboratory research, safety testing, dose studies, clinical trials, manufacturing, and review by a regulatory authority.

Drug-Eluting Stent

A vascular stent coated with a medicine that reduces tissue growth and helps keep the treated vessel open. It is used in selected narrowed or blocked arteries and requires appropriate antiplatelet management.

Drug Eruptions

Alternate plural form; see *Drug Eruption*.

Drug-Food Interaction

A change in a medicine's effect, absorption, or safety caused by food or drink. Food may increase or decrease absorption, while some foods can alter medicine metabolism or raise the risk of adverse effects.

Drug Hypersensitivity

An unusual reaction to a medicine that resembles an allergy. Some reactions involve the immune system, while others have different causes. Symptoms may include a rash, swelling, breathing problems, or fever. Reactions can begin soon after taking a medicine or days later.

Alternate Names:
Drug Hypersensitivity Reaction

Drug Implant

A solid drug-containing pellet, container, or delivery device placed under the skin or in another tissue to release medicine continuously or slowly over an extended period. It may provide local or whole-body treatment; the product determines whether it biodegrades or requires removal and how it is monitored.

Drug-Induced Bullous Disorders

Medication-triggered blistering diseases, including bullous pemphigoid, pemphigus, linear IgA disease, bullous fixed drug eruption, and severe reactions such as Stevens–Johnson syndrome or toxic epidermal necrolysis. New widespread blisters, skin tenderness, peeling, fever, or mouth, eye, or genital involvement is an emergency.

Drug-Induced Gingival Hyperplasia

Enlargement or overgrowth of gum tissue associated especially with phenytoin, cyclosporine or tacrolimus, and calcium-channel blockers such as nifedipine or amlodipine. It can impair brushing, trap plaque, and promote bleeding or periodontal disease; management may include dental care or changing the causative medicine.

Drug-Induced Glaucoma

Glaucoma or raised intraocular pressure caused or worsened by a medicine, commonly corticosteroids and less often agents that produce pupillary block or secondary inflammation. Treatment involves removing the trigger when possible and controlling pressure.

Drug-Induced Hepatotoxicity

Liver injury caused by a medicine, supplement, or other therapeutic exposure. Patterns include hepatocellular injury, cholestasis, or a mixed picture; diagnosis requires exposure review and exclusion of competing causes.

Drug-Induced Liver Injury

Liver damage caused by a medicine, herbal product, or dietary supplement. It may injure liver cells, slow the flow of bile, or do both. The reaction may be predictable from the amount taken or may occur rarely in a person who is unusually sensitive to the substance.

Alternate Names:
DILI; Toxic Hepatitis

Drug-Induced Lupus

A lupus-like autoimmune reaction caused by certain medicines, often producing joint pain, muscle pain, fever, and inflammation around the lungs or heart. Symptoms and abnormal antibodies usually improve after the causative medicine is stopped under medical supervision.

Alternate Names:
DILE

Drug-Induced Lupus Erythematosus

Alternate name; see *Drug-Induced Lupus*.

Alternate Names:
DILE; Drug-Induced Lupus

Drug-Induced Pemphigus

An autoimmune blistering disorder triggered by a medicine, with antibodies disrupting adhesion between epidermal cells and causing fragile blisters or erosions on skin or mucous membranes. Diagnosis uses biopsy and immunofluorescence; the suspected medicine is stopped only with medical guidance, and the eruption may improve after withdrawal.

Drug-Induced Photosensitivity

An exaggerated skin reaction after exposure to sunlight or other ultraviolet light while taking or applying a photosensitizing medicine. Phototoxic reactions resemble an intense sunburn and may occur quickly, whereas photoallergic reactions are delayed and eczematous; sun protection and clinician-guided review of the medicine are important.

Drug-Induced Pigmentation

Darkening or altered colour of the skin, nails, teeth, or mucous membranes caused by a medicine or its metabolites. Causes include increased melanin, drug or metabolite deposition, and iron deposition; examples include minocycline, amiodarone, clofazimine, antimalarials, and some chemotherapy medicines.

Drug-Induced Pulmonary Toxicity

Respiratory injury caused by a medicine, radiation, or treatment-related immune reaction. It may appear as pneumonitis, organizing pneumonia, fibrosis, edema, hemorrhage, bronchospasm, or pulmonary vascular disease; diagnosis requires temporal review and exclusion of infection and other causes.

Drug Repurposing

Studying or using a medicine developed for one condition to treat a different condition. Earlier safety information may help, but the new use still needs evidence about effectiveness, dose, interactions, and risks.

Drug Safety

The prevention, detection, and management of harmful effects, interactions, errors, and misuse involving medicines. It includes choosing the right medicine and dose, checking allergies and interactions, following instructions, monitoring effects, and reporting suspected problems.

Drug Screening

Testing a sample such as urine, blood, saliva, or hair for selected drugs or their breakdown products. Initial results can be falsely positive or negative and may require confirmation with a more specific test.

Drugs That May Cause Erection Problems

Some medicines can contribute to difficulty getting or keeping an erection by affecting blood flow, hor-

mones, nerves, or mood. A clinician should review the timing and all medicines before changing treatment.

Drug Testing

Laboratory analysis of blood, urine, saliva, hair, or another sample to detect medicines, recreational drugs, their breakdown products, or poisons. The test's purpose, detection limits, timing, and medicines taken affect interpretation.

Drusen

Yellow-white deposits that form beneath the retina, often with aging. Small deposits may cause no symptoms; many or larger deposits can be associated with age-related macular degeneration and need eye examination.

Dry Age-Related Macular Degeneration

Alternate name; see *Dry Macular Degeneration*.

Dry AMD

Alternate name; see *Dry Macular Degeneration*.

Dry Beriberi

The predominantly neurologic form of severe thiamine deficiency. It can cause symmetric peripheral neuropathy, burning or numb feet, muscle weakness, wasting, impaired reflexes, and difficulty walking.

Dry Cell Battery Poisoning

Injury caused by swallowing or contact with the contents of a dry-cell battery. A swallowed button battery can rapidly burn and perforate the esophagus and is a time-critical medical emergency.

Dry Cough

A cough that produces little or no mucus. Common causes include viral infection, asthma, acid reflux, allergies, smoking, certain medicines, and other airway or lung conditions.

Dry Cupping

A complementary treatment in which cups create suction on intact skin without making cuts. It may temporarily relieve some muscle pain, but evidence is limited; bruising, burns, skin injury, infection, and worsening of skin disease can occur.

Dry Drowning

Obsolete, nonstandard term that has no accepted diagnostic definition; see *Drowning*.

Dry Eye

A disorder in which tears are insufficient or evaporate too quickly, causing burning, grittiness, redness, watering, light sensitivity, or blurred vision. Long-lasting disease can damage the eye surface.

Alternate Names:
Keratoconjunctivitis Sicca; Dry Eyes

Dry Eye Disease

Alternate name; see *Dry Eye*.

Dry Eye Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Dry Eye*.

Dry Gangrene

Tissue death caused by a severe loss of blood flow, often in a toe, foot, or finger. The area may become cold, dry, shrunken, and dark. Infection can develop, and the affected tissue may progress to wet gangrene.

Alternate Names:
Mummification; Senile Gangrene; Arterial Gangrene

Dry Hair

Hair that feels rough, brittle, dull, or frizzy because its outer layer is damaged or lacks moisture. Heat, chemical treatments, weather, frequent washing, nutritional problems, and thyroid disease may contribute.

Dry Ice

Solid carbon dioxide that changes directly into a cold gas. Contact can cause severe cold burns, and gas in an enclosed space can displace oxygen and cause unconsciousness or suffocation; never seal it in a container.

Dry Macular Degeneration

The more common form of age-related macular degeneration, in which light-sensing cells in the macula gradually deteriorate without bleeding from new abnormal vessels. It can cause slow loss of detailed central vision.

Alternate Names:
Nonexudative AMD; Non-Neovascular AMD

Dry Mouth

A feeling that the mouth does not have enough saliva, also called xerostomia. It may be caused by medicines, dehydration, mouth breathing, anxiety, disease of the saliva-making glands, radiation, or other illness. It can make speaking, swallowing, and tasting harder and harm teeth.

Alternate Names:
Cottonmouth

Dry Mouth Xerostomia

Alternate name; see *Xerostomia*.

Alternate Names:
Oral Dryness

Dry Powder Inhaler

A breath-powered device that delivers powdered medicine into the lungs. It does not require pressing and breathing at the same time; dose delivery depends on the strength and timing of inhalation.

Dry-Powder Inhaler

Alternate spelling; see *Dry Powder Inhaler*.

Dry Skin

Skin that is rough, scaly, tight, or itchy because it has lost moisture or its protective barrier is damaged. Aging, cold or dry air, frequent washing, eczema, medicines, and some illnesses can contribute.

Dry Skin and Itching

Xerosis with pruritus, often caused by low humidity, irritating products, eczema, medicines, or systemic disease. Persistent, widespread, severe, or sleep-disrupting itch may be associated with dermatologic, liver, kidney, thyroid, blood, or neurologic causes.

Dry Socket

Painful inflammation after tooth extraction when the protective blood clot is lost or breaks down too early. Severe pain may begin a few days later and spread to the ear or jaw.

DSM

The Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, a reference that describes recognized mental-health diagnoses and their criteria. Clinicians use it with history and examination; it does not replace individual clinical judgment.

DSPS

Alternate name; see *Delayed Sleep Phase*.

DSRCT

Alternate name; see *Desmoplastic Small Round Cell Tumor*.

DSWPD

Alternate name; see *Delayed Sleep Phase*.

DTaP

A vaccine for infants and young children that protects against diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis (whooping cough). It is given as a series, with later booster vaccines used as children grow older.

D Trisomy Syndrome

Older name for trisomy 13; see *Patau Syndrome*.

Dual Antiplatelet Therapy

Use of two antiplatelet medicines, commonly aspirin with a P2Y12 inhibitor such as clopidogrel, ticagrelor, or prasugrel. It is used for selected periods in conditions including acute coronary syndrome, after coronary stenting, and after some minor ischemic strokes or high-risk transient ischemic attacks; indications and duration depend on the clinical setting.

Alternate Names:
DAPT

Dual-Energy CT

A CT scan that uses two X-ray energy levels to help

distinguish materials in the body. It can improve evaluation of kidney stones, gout, blood vessels, bleeding, and some tissues while using the usual CT principles and risks.

Dual Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry

See *Bone Mineral Density Test*.

Alternate Names:
DXA; DEXA

Dual-Energy X-Ray Absorptiometry

Alternate spelling; see *Bone Mineral Density Test*.

Dual-Photon Absorptiometry

An older test that used two photon energy levels to estimate bone mineral content. It has largely been replaced by dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry for measuring bone density and fracture risk.

Duane Retraction Syndrome

A birth-related eye-movement disorder caused by abnormal nerve control of an eye muscle. Turning the eye inward or outward may be limited, and the eyeball may pull backward and the eyelids narrow.

Alternate Names:
DR Syndrome; Duane Syndrome; Stilling-Turk-Duane Syndrome

Dubin-Johnson Syndrome

An inherited liver-transport disorder in which conjugated bilirubin is not moved normally into bile. It causes intermittent mild jaundice, often triggered by illness or stress, but usually does not cause serious liver damage.

Dubowitz Syndrome

A rare developmental condition associated with poor growth, a small head, characteristic facial features, developmental or learning difficulties, and variable immune, skin, or behavioral problems. Features differ among affected people.

Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy

A severe, inherited genetic muscle disorder that predominantly affects boys, caused by mutations in the gene responsible for producing dystrophin, a protein that protects and strengthens muscle fibers. Without dystrophin, muscle cells gradually break down and weaken over time. Symptoms usually appear in early childhood as difficulty walking, frequent falls, and trouble climbing stairs, progressing to widespread muscle wasting that eventually affects the heart and breathing muscles.

Alternate Names:
Duchenne Dystrophy

Duck Embryo Vaccine

An older rabies vaccine made by growing inactivated rabies virus in duck embryos. It has largely been replaced by safer, more consistent cell-culture vaccines and is not commonly used today.

Duct

A tube or channel that carries fluid within the body, such as bile, pancreatic juice, saliva, tears, or secretions from a gland. Blockage or injury can cause pain, swelling, infection, or impaired organ function.

Ductal Carcinoma

A cancer that begins in cells lining a duct. The term most often describes breast cancer or pancreatic cancer; its behavior and treatment depend on the organ, spread, and tumor features.

Ductal Carcinoma In Situ

A noninvasive breast cancer in which abnormal cells remain inside the milk ducts and have not invaded surrounding breast tissue. It is classified as stage 0 breast cancer; some cases may progress to invasive cancer.

Alternate Names:
Stage 0 Breast Cancer

Ductal-Dependent Lesions

Serious congenital heart defects in which blood flow to the lungs or body depends on the fetal ductus arteriosus remaining open after birth. Affected newborns may rapidly become blue, breathless, pale, or shocked.

Duct Ectasia

Alternate name; see *Mammary Duct Ectasia*.

Ductless Glands

Glands that release hormones directly into the bloodstream rather than through a tube. Examples include the pituitary, thyroid, adrenal glands, and pancreatic islets; their hormones regulate growth, metabolism, stress, and reproduction.

Ductus Arteriosus

A blood vessel in the fetus connecting the pulmonary artery to the aorta, allowing blood to bypass the lungs before birth. It normally closes soon after birth; failure to close can strain the heart and lungs.

Ductus Venosus

A fetal blood vessel that directs oxygen-rich blood from the umbilical vein toward the heart while partly bypassing the liver. It normally closes after birth; abnormal fetal flow can indicate circulatory or placental problems.

Duffy-Null Associated Neutrophil Count

A lower neutrophil count associated with the Duffy-null red-cell blood-group phenotype, which is more common in some ancestral populations. It is not generally associated with increased infection risk and, by itself, does not indicate impaired immune defense.

Dugas Sign

A shoulder examination sign in which a person cannot touch the opposite shoulder with the injured arm while keeping the elbow against the chest. It may occur with a shoulder dislocation.

Alternate Names:
Dugas' Sign; Anterior Shoulder Dislocation Test

Duke Criteria

A set of clinical, blood-culture, and heart-imaging findings used to classify suspected infective endocarditis. The criteria combine major and minor findings; the result supports diagnosis alongside the patient's history and examination.

Alternate Names:
Modified Duke Criteria; Duke Endocarditis Criteria

Dukes Classification

An older system for describing how far colorectal cancer has spread through the bowel wall, into nearby lymph nodes, or to distant organs. Modern staging systems are more detailed and are generally preferred.

Dull Pain

Aching, heavy, or pressure-like pain that is not sharp or stabbing. It can arise from muscles, organs, inflammation, or other tissues, and its significance depends on location, duration, associated symptoms, and examination findings.

Duloxetine

A medicine that increases serotonin and norepinephrine signaling in the brain. It treats depression, anxiety, some nerve pain, fibromyalgia, and chronic muscle or bone pain; nausea, sleep changes, sweating, and withdrawal symptoms may occur.

Duloxetine Hydrochloride

The salt form of duloxetine, a medicine used for depression, anxiety, some nerve pain, fibromyalgia, and chronic muscle or bone pain. It may cause nausea, sleep changes, sweating, blood-pressure changes, or withdrawal symptoms.

Dumbbell Ossification

Bone formation or a bone lesion shaped like a dumbbell, often extending through an opening between the spinal canal and surrounding tissues. Imaging is needed to identify its cause and relationship to nerves or other structures.

Dumdum Fever

An older name for visceral leishmaniasis, a parasitic infection transmitted by sandflies. It can cause prolonged fever, weight loss, enlarged spleen or liver, anemia, low blood counts, and life-threatening illness without treatment.

Dumping Syndrome

Symptoms caused by food moving too quickly from the stomach into the small intestine, often after stomach surgery. Early symptoms include cramps, diarrhea, flushing, sweating, dizziness, and a fast heartbeat; later low blood sugar may occur.

Dunbar Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome*.

Dunphy Sign

A clinical sign of acute appendicitis and localized peritoneal inflammation characterized by a sharp exacerbation of right lower quadrant abdominal pain triggered by coughing.

Alternate Names:
Dunphy's Sign; Cough Sign of Appendicitis

Duodenal

Relating to the duodenum, the first part of the small intestine immediately beyond the stomach. This segment receives bile and pancreatic juice and begins digestion and absorption of nutrients.

Duodenal Adenocarcinoma

A cancer arising from gland-forming cells in the duodenum. It may cause abdominal pain, vomiting, bleeding, anemia, jaundice, or blockage; diagnosis usually requires imaging, endoscopy, and tissue sampling.

Duodenal Atresia

A birth defect in which the duodenum is completely blocked, preventing food and digestive fluid from passing. Newborns usually develop green vomiting and feeding difficulty; it is often associated with other birth defects and requires surgery.

Duodenal Bulb

The widened first part of the duodenum just beyond the stomach outlet. It receives partly digested food and is a common site for peptic ulcers; inflammation or scarring can narrow it and delay passage.

Duodenal Disease

Any disorder affecting the duodenum, such as inflammation, ulcer, infection, bleeding, blockage, poor nutrient absorption, or a growth. Symptoms may include upper-abdominal pain, vomiting, anemia, or weight loss.

Duodenal Diverticulum

A pouch that bulges outward from the duodenal wall, often near the openings of the bile and pancreatic ducts. It commonly causes no symptoms but can rarely lead to bleeding, inflammation, blockage, pancreatitis, or bile-duct infection.

Duodenal Fistula

An abnormal connection between the duodenum and another organ, bowel segment, or skin. Digestive fluid may leak through it, causing infection, skin damage, dehydration, electrolyte loss, or poor nutrition.

Duodenal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the duodenum, often caused by a peptic ulcer, inflammation, abnormal blood vessel, injury, or cancer. It may cause black stools, vomiting blood, weakness, dizziness, anemia, or shock.

Duodenal Infection

Infection affecting the duodenum, caused by bacteria, parasites, viruses, or spread from nearby digestive disease. Symptoms can include upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, fever, or bleeding.

Duodenal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the duodenum that may be benign or cancerous. It can cause pain, bleeding, vomiting, blockage, anemia, or jaundice; evaluation depends on its size, location, appearance, and tissue type.

Duodenal Obstruction

A partial or complete blockage that prevents food and digestive fluid from passing through the duodenum. It can cause repeated vomiting, abdominal swelling, pain, and dehydration.

Duodenal Papilla

A small raised opening in the duodenal wall where bile and pancreatic juice enter the intestine. Narrowing, blockage, or inflammation at this site can cause jaundice, pancreatitis, or digestive symptoms.

Duodenal Perforation

A hole through the full thickness of the duodenal wall, usually caused by a severe ulcer, injury, or a medical procedure. Sudden severe abdominal pain, rigid muscles, and infection of the abdominal lining require emergency treatment.

Duodenal Stenosis

Narrowing of the duodenum that partly blocks passage of food and digestive fluid. It may cause vomiting, abdominal swelling, pain, early fullness, poor feeding, or dehydration; treatment depends on the cause and severity.

Duodenal Tissue Culture

Microbiologic culture of endoscopic mucosal biopsy specimens obtained from the duodenum to diagnose atypical bacterial, mycobacterial, or fungal infections of the proximal small intestine.

Alternate Names:
Duodenal Biopsy Culture; Small Intestine Mucosal Culture

Duodenal Ulcer

An open sore in the duodenal lining, commonly related to Helicobacter pylori infection or anti-inflammatory medicines. It may cause upper-abdominal pain and can bleed, perforate the bowel, or obstruct food passage.

Duodenitis

Inflammation of the duodenal lining, which may result from Helicobacter pylori, excess acid, anti-inflammatory medicines, infection, celiac disease, or inflammatory bowel disease. It can cause upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, or bleeding.

Duodenoscope

A flexible, side-viewing endoscope passed through the mouth into the duodenum. Its movable tip elevator helps guide instruments into the bile and pancreatic ducts during endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography (ERCP), which can be used to remove stones or place stents.

Duodenostomy

A surgically created opening from the duodenum to the skin or another part of the intestine. It may be used in selected cases for feeding, drainage, or bypassing a blockage.

Duodenum

The first part of the small intestine, between the stomach and jejunum. It receives bile and pancreatic juice, mixes them with stomach contents, and begins much of the digestion and absorption of nutrients.

Duplex Doppler Ultrasound Scanning

An ultrasound test that shows the structure of blood vessels and measures the direction and speed of blood flow. It can detect narrowing, blockage, clots, aneurysms, or abnormal connections without radiation.

Alternate Names:
Duplex Ultrasound

Duplex Surveillance

Planned examinations and ultrasound checks of a blood vessel, graft, stent, aneurysm, or dialysis access. Monitoring can detect recurrent narrowing, clotting, leakage, or failure before serious symptoms develop.

Duplex Ultrasound

An ultrasound examination that combines pictures of body structures with Doppler measurement of blood flow. It is commonly used to assess blood vessels and can identify narrowing, blockage, clots, or abnormal flow.

Duplication

A genetic change in which a section of DNA or a chromosome is copied one or more extra times. The additional genetic material can alter how much of a gene is active and may cause a health condition,

although some duplications have little or no effect.

Dupuytren Contracture

Progressive thickening and shortening of tissue in the palm that pulls one or more fingers toward the palm and can limit hand function.

Alternate Names:
Dupuytren Disease; Palmar Fibromatosis

Dupuytren's Disease

A condition in which tissue under the skin of the palm thickens and tightens. It can form cords that gradually bend one or more fingers toward the palm, making them hard to straighten. The ring and little fingers are often affected.

Dupuytren's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Dupuytren's Disease*.

Dura

Alternate name; see *Dura Mater*.

Durable Power Of Attorney

A legal authorization allowing a designated person to act or make decisions for another person when specified conditions are met. In healthcare, it may appoint a healthcare proxy.

Dural Arteriovenous Fistula

An abnormal direct connection between an artery and a vein in the tough covering around the brain or spinal cord. It may cause a pulsing sound in the ear, headache, seizures, vision or other nerve problems, or bleeding.

Alternate Names:
DAVF

Dural Arteriovenous Fistulas

Plural form; see *Dural Arteriovenous Fistula*.

Dural Sac

The tough, tubular covering around the spinal cord, its surrounding fluid, and the spinal nerve roots inside the spinal canal. A tear can allow spinal-fluid leakage and cause positional headaches.

Dural Venous Sinuses

Channels between layers of the brain's tough covering that collect blood and cerebrospinal fluid and drain them toward the neck veins. A clot in these channels can cause headache, seizures, vision problems, or stroke-like symptoms.

Dura Mater

The tough outer layer of tissue surrounding and protecting the brain and spinal cord. It helps support blood vessels and contains the fluid-filled coverings around the central nervous system.

Durapatite

Another name for hydroxyapatite, the calcium-phosphate mineral that gives bones and teeth much of their hardness. Its amount and arrangement contribute to bone strength and can change in metabolic bone disease.

Duroziez Sign

An auscultatory vascular sign of severe aortic regurgitation consisting of a double murmur heard over the femoral artery—a systolic murmur generated by proximal compression and a diastolic murmur generated by distal compression with the stethoscope diaphragm.

Alternate Names:
Duroziez's Sign; Duroziez Double Murmur

Durules

A formulation designed to release a medicine slowly over an extended period. Crushing or chewing some such tablets or pellets may release too much medicine at once.

Dust

Small solid particles suspended in air or settled on surfaces. Inhaled dust can irritate the nose and lungs; some types can cause allergy, asthma, infection, poisoning, or long-term lung disease.

Dust Disease

A broad term for lung disease caused by inhaling dust, especially at work. Mineral-dust diseases in-

clude silicosis, asbestosis, and coal workers' pneumoconiosis; some organic dusts can cause occupational asthma or hypersensitivity pneumonitis.

Dust Mite Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins from tiny mites living in household dust. It can cause sneezing, blocked or itchy nose, watery eyes, cough, wheezing, eczema flares, or asthma symptoms.

Alternate Names:
House Dust Mite Hypersensitivity; Dust Mite Sensitization

Dutasteride

A medicine that lowers the hormone dihydrotestosterone and gradually shrinks an enlarged prostate. It improves urinary symptoms and lowers retention risk but may reduce sexual function and lowers the blood-test level used to screen for prostate cancer.

DVT

A blood clot in a deep vein, usually in the leg. It can cause swelling, pain, warmth, or redness and may travel to the lungs, causing a life-threatening pulmonary embolism.

DVT Prevention

Steps to reduce the risk of a deep-vein blood clot, including early movement, leg exercises, compression devices, and preventive anticoagulant medicine when appropriate. The choice depends on clot risk and bleeding risk.

Dwarfism

A group of genetic or medical conditions that cause marked short stature. Adult height of 4 feet 10 inches (147 cm) or less is commonly used as a threshold, although some people with a dwarfing condition are taller. Causes include skeletal dysplasias such as achondroplasia, growth-hormone deficiency, and other genetic or medical conditions. In children, short stature is assessed against age- and sex-specific growth standards.

DWI FLAIR Mismatch

A pattern on brain MRI in which an area is abnormal on diffusion images but not yet clearly abnormal on FLAIR images. In selected people with an unknown stroke onset time, it may help identify potentially treatable recent stroke.

Dx

A medical abbreviation for diagnosis or diagnostic assessment. Abbreviations can be misunderstood, especially in patient instructions and other documents.

DXA Scan

Alternate name; see *Bone Mineral Density Test*.

D-Xylose Absorption

An older test of how well the small intestine absorbs a simple sugar after it is swallowed. Low amounts in blood or urine may suggest intestinal lining disease, but kidney function and collection quality affect results.

Dyad

A pair of related people, structures, cells, or measurements considered together. Medical examples include two linked findings or two parts of a cellular or body structure that function together.

Dye

A colored substance used to stain tissue, identify cells, make structures visible, or provide contrast during a medical test. Some dyes can cause allergic reactions or affect the kidneys, especially when injected.

Dye Lasers

Lasers that use a liquid organic dye to produce adjustable wavelengths of light. In medicine, selected wavelengths can treat blood-vessel or pigmented skin lesions; eye and skin protection is essential.

Dye Remover Poisoning

Harm from swallowing, inhaling, or getting dye-removing chemicals on the skin or eyes. Depending on the ingredients, exposure can cause burns, breathing problems, vomiting, poisoning, or organ injury

and needs poison-control advice.

Dying

The physical process of approaching death, often involving increasing weakness, sleepiness, reduced appetite and drinking, changes in breathing, and less responsiveness. Emotional, social, cultural, and spiritual support may help the person and family.

Dynamin Gtpase

A family of GTP-binding proteins that constrict membranes during vesicle budding, endocytosis, and other cell-membrane processes.

Dynamometer

An instrument that measures force, commonly handgrip or muscle strength. Clinicians use the result to compare sides, identify weakness, monitor recovery, and assess physical function during rehabilitation or neurologic examination.

Dynein Atpase

The energy-using activity of dynein, a motor protein that moves materials inside cells along microtubules. Dynein also powers the movement of cilia and flagella, which help move fluid or cells.

Dynorphin

A naturally occurring opioid peptide that mainly activates kappa-opioid receptors in the nervous system. It influences pain, stress, mood, movement, and hormone regulation.

Dyphylline

A bronchodilator used in some countries to relax airway muscles in asthma or chronic obstructive lung disease. It may cause nausea, tremor, headache, nervousness, or a fast heartbeat.

Dysaesthesia

An unpleasant abnormal sensation, such as burning, electric-shock pain, pins and needles, or excessive sensitivity to light touch. It commonly results from nerve injury, diabetes, medicines, or other nerve disease.

Dysania

An informal term for persistent difficulty waking or getting out of bed. It is not a formal medical diagnosis; similar difficulty can occur with sleep deprivation, circadian-rhythm sleep disorders, depression, or sedating medicines.

Dysarthria

Slurred, weak, slow, or poorly coordinated speech caused by a problem in the brain, nerves, or muscles used for speaking. Sudden dysarthria can be a sign of stroke.

Dysautonomia

A disorder of the automatic nervous system that controls blood pressure, heart rate, sweating, temperature, digestion, bladder function, and sexual function. Causes include nerve disease, diabetes, medicines, and inherited conditions.

Dysbarism

Illness caused by a change in surrounding pressure, usually during diving, flying, or hyperbaric treatment. It includes decompression sickness and pressure injury to the ears, sinuses, lungs, or other tissues.

Dysbiosis

An imbalance or change in the community of microorganisms living in the body, especially the intestine. Antibiotics, infection, diet, and illness may contribute; dysbiosis is associated with some digestive and inflammatory disorders, but it is not always a proven cause.

Alternate Names:
Gut Microbiome Imbalance

Dyscalculia

A persistent difficulty understanding numbers, quantities, or arithmetic that is not explained by inadequate teaching or general intellectual disability. It may begin during development or follow brain injury and can affect school or daily tasks.

Dyschezia

Difficult or painful passage of stool, often with excessive straining or a feeling of incomplete emptying. Causes include constipation, pelvic-floor coordination problems, anal disorders, and other bowel disease.

Dyschromatosis

A pattern of skin pigmentation with intermixed hyperpigmented and hypopigmented macules, often small and irregular. The term describes a group of pigmentary disorders rather than one specific disease; inherited and acquired forms occur.

Dyscrasia

An abnormal, diseased, or disordered state of the blood or bone marrow, derived historically from the humoral theory of medicine. In modern hematology, the term is applied to specific hematologic pathologies, such as blood dyscrasias (e.g., severe cytopenias, coagulopathies, aplastic anemia) and plasma cell dyscrasias (clonal neoplastic expansions of immunoglobulin-producing plasma cells, including multiple myeloma, monoclonal gammopathy of undetermined significance [MGUS], and AL amyloidosis).

Dyscrasias

Plural form; see *Dyscrasia*.

Dysdiadochokinesia

Difficulty making quick, repeated movements in opposite directions, such as rapidly turning the hands over and back. It can occur with problems in the cerebellum or its nerve pathways.

Alternate Names:
Adiadochokinesia

Dysdiadochokinesis

Alternate name; see *Dysdiadochokinesia*.

Dysembryoplastic Neuroepithelial Tumor

A usually slow-growing, low-grade brain tumor that develops most often in the outer part of the brain in children or young adults. It commonly causes long-standing focal seizures and is often treatable with surgery.

Dysentery

Diarrhea with visible blood, often with cramps, fever, mucus, and an urgent need to pass stool. Several bacteria and parasites can cause it.

Dysesthesia

An unpleasant abnormal sensation, such as burning, electric-shock pain, or painful sensitivity to light touch. It may result from injury or disease of nerves in the brain, spinal cord, or limbs.

Dysferlinopathy

A group of inherited muscle diseases caused by changes in both copies of the DYSF gene, which makes a muscle-membrane repair protein. Weakness often begins in adolescence or early adulthood, affecting the hips, shoulders, or calves.

Alternate Names:
DYSF-Related Muscular Dystrophy; Dysferlin Deficiency

Dysfibrinogenemia

An inherited or acquired condition in which fibrinogen, a blood-clotting protein, has abnormal structure or function. It may cause unusual bleeding, excessive clotting, or no symptoms and is diagnosed with clotting and specialized blood tests.

Dysfunction

Abnormal, reduced, or poorly controlled function of an organ, tissue, body system, or process. It may be temporary or permanent and can result from disease, injury, medicines, inherited conditions, stress, or aging.

Dysfunctional Uterine Bleeding

Older term; see *Abnormal Uterine Bleeding*.

Dysfunctional Voiding

Abnormal coordination between the bladder muscle and the muscles around the urethra during urination. It may cause a weak or interrupted stream, straining,

incomplete emptying, urinary infections, wetting, or constipation, especially in children.

Dysgammaglobulinemia

An abnormal level or pattern of antibodies in the blood, with some antibody types low or absent and others normal or increased. It may cause repeated infections, autoimmune problems, or no symptoms and is identified by blood tests.

Dysgerminoma

A cancer of the ovary arising from germ cells, the cells that can develop into eggs. It occurs most often in adolescents and young adults and may cause pelvic pain, swelling, or an abdominal mass.

Dysgeusia

An altered sense of taste, including reduced, distorted, or unpleasant taste. Causes include viral infection, mouth or nose disease, nerve injury, nutritional deficiency, dry mouth, medicines, and other illnesses.

Dysgraphia

A persistent difficulty with handwriting, spelling, or expressing ideas in writing despite appropriate learning opportunities. It may reflect problems with motor skills, language, attention, or brain function and can occur with other learning disorders.

Dyshidrosis

Alternate name; see *Dyshidrotic Eczema*.

Dyshidrotic Eczema

A recurrent, intensely itchy eruption of small, deep-seated fluid-filled blisters on the palms, sides of the fingers, and sometimes the soles. The blisters often occur symmetrically and may be followed by peeling or fissures. Its cause is not fully understood; the condition is also known as pompholyx.

Alternate Names:
Dyshidrotic Dermatitis

Dyskeratosis Congenita

A rare hereditary telomere biology disorder caused by mutations in telomere maintenance genes, characterized by the classic triad of reticulated reticular skin hyperpigmentation, dystrophic nails, and oral mucosal leukoplakia, associated with a high risk of progressive bone marrow failure and pulmonary fibrosis.

Alternate Names:
Zinsser-Cole-Engman Syndrome; Telomere Biology Disorder

Dyskinesia

Abnormal movement that is often involuntary, excessive, repetitive, twisting, or irregular. It may result from neurologic disease or medicines, including long-term treatment for movement disorders, and can interfere with walking, speaking, or daily activities.

Dyslexia

A learning disorder involving persistent difficulty recognizing words accurately or fluently, decoding them, spelling, or linking letters with speech sounds. It is not caused by low intelligence or poor motivation and may continue into adulthood.

Alternate Names:
Specific Reading Disorder; Developmental Dyslexia

Dyslipidemia

An abnormal level or pattern of blood lipids or lipoproteins, such as elevated LDL cholesterol or triglycerides, low HDL cholesterol, or a combination. It is associated with increased cardiovascular risk; severe hypertriglyceridemia can cause acute pancreatitis.

Alternate Names:
Dyslipidaemia; Dyslipidaemias

Dyslipidemias

Alternate plural; see *Dyslipidemia*.

Dysmenorrhea

Painful menstrual periods, usually causing cramping in the lower abdomen and sometimes back pain, nausea, diarrhea, headache, or dizziness. Severe, new, or worsening pain may indicate an underlying pelvic disorder.

Dysmenorrhea (Painful Menstruation)

Alternate name; see *Dysmenorrhea*.

Dysmenorrhoea

Painful menstrual periods. Primary pain occurs without another pelvic disease, while secondary pain results from a condition such as endometriosis, fibroids, adenomyosis, pelvic infection, or an intrauterine device.

Dysmetria

Inability to judge or control the distance, force, or speed of a voluntary movement. A person may overshoot or undershoot a target; it commonly reflects dysfunction of the cerebellum or its connecting pathways.

Dysmyelogenic Leukodystrophy

An older or nonspecific term for a leukodystrophy in which myelin develops abnormally. Modern diagnosis generally identifies the specific genetic or acquired disorder and its pattern of hypomyelination, dysmyelination, or demyelination.

Alternate Names:
Dysmyelinating Leukodystrophy

Dysorexia

An abnormal appetite, including little desire to eat, excessive hunger, or disordered eating. It may result from illness, medicines, emotional distress, metabolic disease, or an eating disorder and can affect nutrition and weight.

Dysostoses

Inherited or developmental conditions in which one or more bones form or grow abnormally. They may affect the skull, face, spine, ribs, arms, or legs and can alter body shape, movement, growth, hearing, breathing, or other functions.

Dyspareunia

Recurrent or persistent genital or pelvic pain before, during, or after sexual activity, especially attempted vaginal penetration. Pain may be at the vaginal opening or deeper in the pelvis and can result from dryness, infection, skin disease, pelvic-floor muscle spasm, endometriosis, inflammation, injury, or emotional factors.

Dyspepsia

Recurring discomfort in the upper abdomen, often called indigestion. It may feel like pain or burning, uncomfortable fullness after a meal, or getting full too soon. Causes include ulcers, reflux, some medicines, or no visible cause.

Alternate Names:
Indigestion; Upset Stomach

Dyspeptic

Describing indigestion symptoms such as upper-abdominal discomfort or burning, early fullness, bloating, belching, or nausea, especially after eating.

Dysphagia

Trouble swallowing food, liquid, or saliva. It may be hard to start a swallow, move food through the throat, or pass it down the food pipe; coughing, choking, or food sticking may occur. Causes include problems with the shape or movement of the throat or food pipe, nerves, or muscles.

Alternate Names:
Deglutition Disorder

Dysphagia Diet

Foods with modified texture or drinks with modified thickness, selected to accommodate a person's swallowing difficulty. A swallowing assessment guides the consistency; these changes may improve swallowing safety but do not eliminate aspiration risk and can affect fluid or food intake.

Dysphagia Lusoria

Difficulty swallowing caused by compression of the esophagus by a congenital abnormality of the aortic arch or its branches. The usual cause is an aberrant right subclavian artery that arises from the left side of the aortic arch and passes behind the esophagus to reach the right arm; less common causes include a double aortic arch or a right aortic arch with an aberrant left subclavian artery. These vascular abnormalities may be present without causing

symptoms; the term refers to cases in which they cause swallowing difficulty.

Dysphagia Rehabilitation

Therapy to improve safe swallowing, nutrition, and hydration. It may include swallowing exercises, posture or pacing strategies, food-texture changes, and caregiver education based on the cause and assessment.

Dysphasia

Difficulty using or understanding language because of a problem in the brain's language areas. It may affect speaking, understanding, reading, or writing; many clinicians use the clearer term aphasia.

Dysphonia

An abnormal voice, such as hoarseness, breathiness, roughness, strain, weakness, or loss of voice. Causes include infection, vocal-cord swelling or growths, nerve problems, voice overuse, reflux, and cancer.

Dysphonia Spastica

Alternate name; see *Spasmodic Dysphonia*.

Dysphoria

A state of marked emotional distress, unease, or dissatisfaction. Gender dysphoria specifically means distress related to a difference between experienced gender and sex assigned at birth; it is not itself a mental illness.

Dysplasia

Abnormal size, shape, or arrangement of cells in a tissue. It is not cancer, but some forms—especially when severe or persistent—can increase the chance of cancer and may need monitoring or treatment.

Dysplasia Epiphysealis Hemimelica (Trevor Disease)

A rare developmental overgrowth of cartilage in one side of an epiphysis, usually affecting a lower-limb joint in childhood. It can cause asymmetric bony masses, pain, stiffness, deformity, or restricted movement and is evaluated with radiographs or MRI.

Dysplastic Melanocytic Nevi Pathology

Melanocytic nevi with architectural disorder and variable cytologic atypia, often showing bridging of rete ridges, lamellar fibroplasia, and atypical melanocytes. The degree of atypia is graded and must be distinguished from melanoma.

Dysplastic Nevi

Plural form; see *Dysplastic Nevus*.

Dysplastic Nevus

An atypical melanocytic mole with clinical or microscopic features such as asymmetry, irregular borders, uneven color, or disordered cell growth. Most do not become melanoma, but multiple dysplastic nevi are associated with increased melanoma risk and can resemble early melanoma.

Dyspnea

A person's uncomfortable feeling of difficult breathing, breathlessness, or not getting enough air. It may occur with lung, heart, blood, muscle, or anxiety-related conditions.

Alternate Names:
Breathing Difficulty; Breathlessness; Dyspnoea

Dyspnea On Exertion

Shortness of breath that occurs or worsens with physical activity. It may result from heart or lung disease, anemia, poor fitness, or other conditions; symptoms may be new, severe, or rapidly worsening.

Dyspnoea

Alternate name; see *Dyspnea*.

Dyspraxia

A developmental difficulty planning and coordinating movements that interferes with daily activities, learning, or motor skills. It is not explained by muscle weakness, loss of sensation, or inadequate opportunity to learn.

Alternate Names:
Developmental Coordination Disorder

Dysraphism

A birth defect caused by incomplete joining of developing body structures, especially the spinal cord or spinal bones. Effects range from a small skin mark to weakness, loss of sensation, or bladder and bowel problems.

Dysrhythmia

An abnormal heart rhythm that may be too fast, too slow, or irregular. Some cause no symptoms; others cause palpitations, dizziness, fainting, chest pain, stroke, or inadequate blood flow.

Dyssomnia

A primary category of sleep disorders characterized by abnormalities in the amount, quality, or timing of sleep, leading to difficulty initiating, maintaining, or achieving restful sleep, or to excessive daytime sleepiness. Classified into intrinsic sleep disorders (e.g., psychophysiological insomnia, obstructive sleep apnea, central sleep apnea, narcolepsy, idiopathic hypersomnia), extrinsic sleep disorders (e.g., inadequate sleep hygiene, environmental sleep disorder, altitude insomnia), and circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorders (e.g., delayed sleep phase, advanced sleep phase, shift work disorder, jet lag). Distinguished nosologically from parasomnias, which involve abnormal behavioral or physiological events during sleep or sleep-wake transitions.

Alternate Names:
Dyssomnias

Dyssomnias

Plural form; see *Dyssomnia*.

Dysthymic Disorder

Alternate name; see *Persistent Depressive Disorder*.

Dysthyroid Eye Disease

Inflammation and swelling of tissues around the eyes, usually linked to Graves disease. It may cause dry or gritty eyes, puffy lids, bulging eyes, or double vision. Rarely, pressure can damage vision. Smoking increases the risk of severe disease.

Alternate Names:
Graves' Ophthalmopathy; Graves' Orbitopathy; Dysthyroid Ophthalmopathy; TED

Dystocia

Difficult or unusually slow labor caused by ineffective contractions, the baby's size or position, or the mother's pelvis or soft tissues. It can increase risks for both parent and baby and may require assisted delivery or cesarean birth.

Dystonia

A movement disorder marked by involuntary, often sustained or intermittent muscle contractions that cause twisting movements or abnormal postures. It may be painful and affect one or several body regions; dystonia can occur on its own or with genetic conditions, brain disorders, or certain medicines.

Dystonia Disorder

Alternate name; see *Dystonia*.

Dystonin

A protein made from the DST gene that helps attach the internal framework of cells to other cell structures. Harmful gene changes can cause inherited nerve disease, muscle weakness, and fragile or blistering skin.

Dystrophia Unguium

Abnormal nail growth, shape, color, or texture. Causes include injury, fungal infection, inflammation, poor nutrition, medicines, reduced blood flow, and inherited disorders; treatment depends on the cause.

Dystrophic Calcification

Buildup of calcium salts in damaged, dead, or chronically inflamed tissue even though the blood calcium level is normal. It can occur in scars, diseased valves, tumors, or injured muscles and may impair function.

Dystrophin

A large sub-sarcolemmal cytoskeletal structural protein that anchors the internal actin cytoskeleton of skeletal and cardiac muscle fibers to the extracellular matrix through the dystrophin-associated

glycoprotein complex; mutations in the *DMD* gene lead to Duchenne and Becker muscular dystrophies.

Dystrophin-Glycoprotein Complex

A group of proteins that connects the internal framework of muscle cells to their surrounding support tissue and protects the cell membrane during contraction. Changes in its components can cause several inherited muscular dystrophies.

Alternate Names:
DGC; Dystrophin-Associated Glycoprotein Complex (DAGC)

Dystrophy

Abnormal development or progressive deterioration of a tissue or organ. The term is used in the names of distinct disorders, such as muscular, retinal, and corneal dystrophies; the cause and effects differ among them.

Dysuria

Pain, burning, or discomfort during urination. Common causes include bladder or urethral infection, vaginal or penile inflammation, stones, irritation, and sexually transmitted infections; fever, flank pain, pregnancy, or blood in urine may accompany more serious causes.

Alternate Names:
Painful Urination

E

Eagle Syndrome

A rare cause of throat, face, jaw, or neck pain related to an unusually long bony projection near the skull base or a hardened nearby ligament. Pain may worsen with swallowing or turning the head.

Eales Disease

An uncommon inflammatory disorder of small retinal veins, usually affecting otherwise healthy young adults. Blocked vessels can cause abnormal new vessels and bleeding inside the eye, leading to floaters or reduced vision.

Ear

The organ for hearing and balance. The outer ear collects sound, the middle ear transmits vibrations through the eardrum and tiny bones, and the inner ear converts sound and movement into signals sent to the brain.

Earache

Pain in or perceived to come from the ear. It may arise from the ear canal or middle ear, or be referred from nearby structures such as the teeth, jaw joint, throat, or neck.

Alternate Names:
Otalgia

Ear Barotrauma

Ear injury caused by unequal pressure between the middle ear and surrounding air or water, often during flying or diving. It may cause pain, fullness, blocked hearing, ringing, dizziness, bleeding, or a torn eardrum.

Ear Canal

The passage between the outer ear and eardrum. Its skin and earwax protect the middle ear, but infection, injury, foreign objects, or wax buildup can cause pain, discharge, or reduced hearing.

Ear Cartilage

Flexible connective tissue that forms much of the outer ear and gives it shape. Injury or infection can cause pain, swelling, deformity, or damage that permanently changes the ear.

Ear Disease

Alternate name; see *Ear Disorders*.

Ear Disorders

Conditions affecting the outer, middle, or inner ear, including infection, injury, blockage, inflammation, hearing loss, and growths. Symptoms depend on the affected part and may include pain, discharge, ringing, dizziness, or reduced hearing or balance.

Ear Drainage Culture

A laboratory test of fluid draining from the ear to identify bacteria or fungi. Results can guide treatment; normal organisms, contamination, or colonization can affect the findings.

Eardrum

A thin membrane separating the ear canal from the middle ear. Sound makes it vibrate, and the vibration moves the tiny middle-ear bones; infection, pressure, or injury can tear it or reduce hearing.

Eardrum Repair

Treatment to close a hole or repair damage in the eardrum, often using a tissue graft or other surgical technique. It may improve hearing and prevent infection, but healing is not always complete.

Ear Examination

Inspection of the outer ear and ear canal and viewing of the eardrum, usually with an otoscope. Hearing, balance, or additional tests may be added when symptoms suggest middle- or inner-ear disease.

Ear Foreign Body

An object lodged in the ear canal, most often in a child. It may cause pain, reduced hearing, bleeding, discharge, or injury. Button batteries can rapidly damage tissue; two magnets or a magnet and another metal object can pinch tissue between them.

Alternate Names:
Auditory Canal Foreign Body; Aural Foreign Body

Ear Infection

Infection or inflammation affecting part of the ear, including the outer ear, ear canal, middle ear, or inner ear. It may cause ear pain, fever, discharge, reduced hearing, dizziness, or irritability in children.

Earliest Signs Of Increased Intracranial Pressure

Early signs may include worsening headache, vomiting, blurred or double vision, drowsiness, slowed thinking, or behavior change. Causes include bleeding, swelling, infection, a growth, or excess brain fluid.

Earlobes

The soft lower parts of the outer ears, made mainly of skin and fatty or connective tissue without cartilage. They may be affected by piercing injury, infection, cysts, allergic reactions, or tears.

Early Afterdepolarization

An extra abnormal electrical signal during the heart's recovery phase after each beat. It is more likely when the QT interval is prolonged and can trigger dangerous abnormal rhythms.

Alternate Names:
EAD; Early After-Depolarization

Early Childhood Caries

Dental caries affecting one or more primary teeth in a child younger than 6 years. It is a multifactorial disease involving oral bacteria, fermentable carbohydrates, tooth susceptibility, behavior, and social conditions; frequent sugar exposure and enamel defects can increase risk.

Alternate Names:
Early Childhood Tooth Decay

Early Decelerations

A gradual temporary slowing of the fetal heart rate that begins and ends with a uterine contraction, usually from pressure on the baby's head. When isolated, it is generally reassuring, but the complete tracing and clinical situation matter.

Early Detection

Finding a disease at an early stage, before it causes major complications or spreads. It may result from screening or prompt evaluation of symptoms and can improve treatment options for some conditions.

Early Diagnosis

Identifying a disease before it has progressed or caused major complications. Earlier diagnosis may provide more treatment choices, but its benefit depends on the disease and the accuracy and usefulness of available tests.

Early Endosome

A small membrane-bound compartment inside a cell that receives material brought in from the cell surface. It sorts that material for return to the surface, delivery elsewhere in the cell, or breakdown.

Early Gastric Cancer

Stomach cancer limited to the inner lining or the layer just beneath it, whether or not nearby lymph nodes are involved. It may be found early because of screening or testing for digestive symptoms.

Alternate Names:
EGC

Early-Infantile Developmental and Epileptic Encephalopathy

A severe epilepsy syndrome beginning in neonates or infants, characterized by frequent seizures, markedly abnormal brain activity on electroencephalography, and impaired development. Causes may be genetic, structural, metabolic, or unknown; the current International League Against Epilepsy classification includes cases formerly described as Ohtahara syndrome or early myoclonic encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Early Infantile Epileptic Encephalopathy; EIDEE

Early Intervention

Support provided to infants and young children with developmental delays or disabilities. It may include physical, occupational, speech, behavioral, educational, and family services to improve development, function, and participation.

Early-Onset Dementia

Dementia beginning unusually early in life. Modern assessment identifies the specific cause, such as Alzheimer disease, frontotemporal dementia, vascular disease, or an inherited disorder, while also documenting the age at onset.

Alternate Names:
Premature Senility Syndrome (deprecated historical term)

Early-Onset Tremor

Tremor beginning before older adulthood. Causes include essential tremor, medication effects, dystonia, Parkinson disease, metabolic disease, or another neurologic disorder.

Alternate Names:
Presenile Tremor Syndrome (deprecated historical term)

Early Pregnancy Loss

Loss of a pregnancy in the first trimester, most often because of chromosomal abnormalities in the embryo. Evaluation and treatment depend on symptoms, ultrasound, bleeding, infection risk, pregnancy location, and the person's preferences.

Early Puberty

Alternate name; see *Precocious Puberty*.

Early Repolarization Pattern

An electrocardiogram finding of at least 1 mm of elevation at the junction between the QRS complex and ST segment in two or more neighboring inferior or lateral leads, often with notching or slurring at the end of the QRS complex. It is common and usually benign; the pattern alone does not mean a person has an arrhythmic syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Early Repolarization ECG Pattern; BER

Early Repolarization Syndrome

A rare arrhythmic disorder diagnosed when an early-repolarization pattern on an electrocardiogram is present in a person who has survived otherwise unexplained ventricular fibrillation or polymorphic ventricular tachycardia, after other causes are excluded. Most people with the ECG pattern do not have this syndrome.

Alternate Names:
ERS; Malignant Early Repolarization

Early Satiety

Feeling full sooner than expected while eating, sometimes after only a small amount of food. It may result from stomach or digestive disease and may be persistent or associated with weight loss.

Early-Stage Prostate Cancer

Prostate cancer that remains confined to the prostate or nearby tissues and has not spread to distant organs. The term includes cancers with different grades and risks of progression.

Alternate Names:
Early Prostatic Carcinoma; Localized Prostate Cancer

Ear Microbiome

The community of microorganisms living on or in

the ear, especially the ear canal. They interact with skin and earwax and may influence infection risk; moisture, cleaning, hearing devices, inflammation, and illness can change the community.

Ear Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the outer, middle, or inner ear that may be benign or cancerous. It can cause a persistent lump, pain, discharge, hearing loss, dizziness, or facial weakness; imaging or biopsy can help characterize it.

Ear Speculum

A small cone-shaped tip fitted to an otoscope to direct light into the external ear canal and permit examination of the canal and tympanic membrane. Disposable and reusable types are available in different sizes.

Ear Tag

A small, skin-covered projection on or near the outer ear, usually present from birth. It is generally harmless, but examination may be appropriate if it causes problems or occurs with other birth findings.

Ear Thermometer

A device that estimates body temperature by measuring heat in the ear canal near the eardrum. Correct positioning is important; earwax, a small ear canal, or an ear infection can affect the reading.

Ear Tube Insertion

A procedure placing a small ventilation tube through the eardrum to allow air into the middle ear and fluid to drain. It may help repeated infections or persistent fluid but can cause drainage, blockage, scarring, or a persistent opening.

Ear Wax

A waxy mixture of gland secretions and shed skin that protects and cleans the ear canal. A buildup can cause reduced hearing, fullness, ringing, itching, or discomfort; inserted objects can push wax deeper or injure the ear.

Alternate Names:
Cerumen

Earwax

Alternate spelling; see *Ear Wax*.

Earwax Blockage

A buildup of wax that partly or completely blocks the ear canal. It may cause reduced hearing, fullness, ringing, itching, pain, or cough; removal methods vary with the person and ear condition.

Earwax Removal

Removal of excess or impacted earwax by a clinician after examining the ear. Instruments, gentle suction, or irrigation may be used when safe; inserting objects at home can cause injury or push wax deeper.

Eating Disorder

A group of mental-health conditions involving harmful eating patterns that cause distress, medical risk, or impaired functioning. Some involve intense concern about food, weight, or body shape, but avoidant/restrictive food intake disorder (ARFID) does not require body-image concerns. Examples include anorexia nervosa, bulimia nervosa, binge-eating disorder, and ARFID.

Eating Disorders

Alternate name; see *Eating Disorder*.

Eaton-Lambert Syndrome

An uncommon condition in which the immune system interferes with nerve signals to muscles. It causes weakness, often in the hips and shoulders, reduced reflexes, dry mouth, and other automatic-body problems. It can be linked to small-cell lung cancer.

Alternate Names:
Lambert-Eaton Myasthenic Syndrome; LEMS

EB

Alternate name; see *Epidermolysis Bullosa*.

EBCT

Electron-beam computed tomography, an older rapid CT method that was used especially to mea-

sure calcium in the coronary arteries. Newer CT technology is now more commonly used for heart and vessel imaging.

Alternate Names:
Electron-Beam Computed Tomography; Ultrafast CT

Ebola

Alternate name; see *Ebola Virus Disease*.

Ebola Hemorrhagic Fever

Older name; see *Ebola Virus Disease*.

Ebola Virus

A virus that causes Ebola disease. It spreads mainly through direct contact with infected blood or body fluids, usually after symptoms begin; illness may include fever, vomiting, diarrhea, bleeding, shock, and organ failure.

Ebolavirus

Older genus name; see *Orthoebolavirus*.

Ebola Virus Disease

A serious infection caused by Ebola viruses. Symptoms usually begin 2–21 days after exposure and may include fever, weakness, muscle pain, headache, vomiting, or diarrhea; severe illness can cause bleeding, shock, or organ failure. It spreads through contact with an infected person's or animal's blood or body fluids, or with objects contaminated by them. People generally spread the virus after symptoms begin.

Ebola Virus Infection

Alternate name; see *Ebola Virus Disease*.

Ebstein Anomaly

A birth defect in which the tricuspid valve is positioned too low in the right ventricle and does not close normally. It can cause leakage of blood, enlargement of the right heart, blue coloring, heart failure, or abnormal rhythms.

Ebstein's Anomaly

Alternate spelling; see *Ebstein Anomaly*.

EBUS-TBNA

A procedure that uses a flexible breathing-tube camera and ultrasound to locate lymph nodes or masses beside the airways, then obtains tissue with a needle. It helps diagnose and stage lung cancer, sarcoidosis, lymphoma, and tuberculosis.

Alternate Names:
Endobronchial Ultrasound Transbronchial Needle Aspiration; Convex Probe EBUS

Ecbolics

Medicines that stimulate contractions of the uterus. They may be used to start or strengthen labor or control heavy bleeding after birth; excessive contractions can harm the parent or baby.

Eccentric

Positioned away from the center. In exercise, an eccentric muscle action occurs when a muscle produces force while lengthening, such as lowering a weight; it can improve strength but may cause soreness or injury.

Eccentric Action

Muscle contraction that produces force while the muscle lengthens, such as the controlled lowering of an object. It helps control movement and build strength but may cause muscle soreness when new or intense.

Alternate Names:
Eccentric Contraction

Eccentrocyte Count

The number or proportion of eccentrocytes in a blood smear. These red blood cells have hemoglobin displaced to one side because oxidative damage makes part of the cell membrane stick together; they can be seen in oxidative hemolysis.

Ecchymosis

A flat purple, blue, or brown skin mark caused by blood leaking into tissues, commonly after an injury.

Easy or unexplained bruising can also result from medicines, low platelets, clotting disorders, fragile vessels, or illness.

Eccrine Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor arising from eccrine sweat-gland structures. It often presents as a slowly growing plaque or nodule, but may invade nearby tissue or recur; biopsy is required and treatment usually involves complete surgical removal.

Eccrine Gland

A small sweat gland found throughout the skin that releases watery sweat onto the surface. It helps cool the body and is especially numerous on the palms, soles, and forehead.

Eccrine Glands

Plural form; see *Eccrine Gland*.

Eccrine Porocarcinoma

A rare skin cancer arising from cells of sweat-gland ducts. It may appear as a slowly enlarging lump or patch and can recur or spread; biopsy and complete removal are often needed.

Eccrine Poroma

A usually harmless growth arising from a sweat-gland duct, often appearing as a flesh-colored, pink, or reddish lump on a hand or foot. It may bleed or be tender and can be removed if needed.

Eccyesis

Alternate name; see *Ectopic Pregnancy*.

ECG

Abbreviation; see *Electrocardiogram*.

ECG/EKG Machine

A device that records the heart's electrical activity through electrodes placed on the skin. A standard 12-lead recording helps assess rhythm, conduction, heart strain, reduced blood flow, and prior heart injury.

Echinacea

A group of plants used in some herbal products for colds or claimed immune support. Evidence of benefit is inconsistent; allergic reactions and interactions with medicines can occur, especially in people with plant allergies.

Echinocandins

A group of antifungal medicines that stop fungi building their protective cell wall. They are given mainly by injection for serious Candida infections and selected Aspergillus infections; liver reactions and infusion effects can occur.

Echinococcal Cysts

Fluid-filled cysts caused by the larval stage of Echinococcus tapeworms, most often in the liver or lungs. They may remain silent or cause pressure, pain, breathing symptoms, or a severe allergic reaction if they rupture.

Echinococcosis

A parasitic infection caused by larval Echinococcus tapeworms. Cystic disease usually forms cysts in the liver or lungs; alveolar disease grows invasively in the liver and may spread, requiring specialist treatment.

Echinococcus

A group of tapeworms that can cause disease when people swallow eggs from contaminated soil, food, water, or contact with infected animals. Larvae can form cysts or invasive lesions, especially in the liver or lungs.

Echinococcus Granulosus

A tapeworm whose larvae cause cystic echinococcosis. Dogs commonly carry the adult worm, and people become infected by swallowing eggs from contaminated material; cysts most often develop in the liver or lungs.

Echinococcus Multilocularis

A tapeworm species whose larvae cause alveolar echinococcosis. The infection mainly affects the liver, where it grows slowly and invasively and may

spread to other organs.

Echinococcus Vogeli

A tapeworm species that causes polycystic echinococcosis, a disease producing multiple parasitic cysts mainly in the liver and sometimes other abdominal organs.

Echinocytes

Red blood cells with many small, evenly spaced projections around their edges. They may reflect kidney disease or an inherited blood disorder, but can also be created by improper storage or preparation of the blood sample.

Alternate Names:
Burr Cells

Echo

A common abbreviation for echocardiography, an ultrasound test that examines the heart's chambers, valves, pumping action, and blood flow. The full term is preferable in patient instructions.

Echocardiogram

An ultrasound picture of the heart that shows its chambers, valves, pumping movement, and blood flow without ionizing radiation. It helps evaluate heart failure, valve disease, congenital defects, clots, and other heart problems.

Echocardiography

Ultrasound imaging of the heart. It shows the chambers, valves, pumping action, and blood flow; the probe usually scans through the chest and may be passed into the esophagus for closer views.

Echoencephalography

Ultrasound imaging of the brain, historically used mainly in infants to look for enlarged fluid spaces or displacement of brain structures. CT or MRI is now usually preferred for detailed brain imaging.

Echogenic Bowel

An ultrasound finding in which a fetus's bowel appears unusually bright, sometimes as bright as bone. It may be a normal variation or may be associated with infection, chromosome conditions, cystic fibrosis, bleeding, or other fetal problems.

Echogenic Intracardiac Focus

A small bright spot, usually in a muscle inside the fetal heart, seen on ultrasound. When isolated and all other findings and screening are reassuring, it is commonly a harmless variation; its significance depends on the full evaluation.

Echography

Medical ultrasonography, which uses high-frequency sound waves to create images of tissues, organs, blood flow, or a developing fetus.

Echolalia

Repeating words or phrases spoken by someone else, either immediately or after a delay. It can occur in autism, developmental conditions, brain disorders, or some psychiatric illnesses; other symptoms vary.

Echophenomena

Automatic, non-purposeful imitation or repetition of actions, words, or sounds observed in others without explicit awareness or intent. Subtypes include echolalia (vocal repetition) and echopraxia (imitation of movements), commonly observed in Tourette syndrome, catatonia, and certain neurodevelopmental or neurodegenerative disorders.

Echopraxia

Involuntary imitation or repetition of another person's movements. It may occur in some neurologic, developmental, or psychiatric conditions and is interpreted with other symptoms.

Echovirus

A group of enteroviruses spread mainly by the fecal-oral route and sometimes by respiratory secretions. Infection is often mild or silent but can cause rash, respiratory illness, meningitis, encephalitis, heart inflammation, or severe newborn infection.

E-Cigarettes And E-Hookahs

Electronic devices that heat a liquid to produce an inhaled aerosol. Many contain nicotine, which can cause dependence; the aerosol may contain irritants and toxic substances and is not harmless water vapor.

Eclampsia

New-onset seizures during pregnancy or after delivery that are not explained by another cause and are usually associated with preeclampsia. It can cause maternal brain injury, stroke, aspiration, or fetal compromise and is a life-threatening obstetric emergency.

Eclampsia in Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Eclampsia*.

ECMO

Alternate name; see *Extracorporeal Membrane Oxygenation*.

ECOG Performance Status

A scale from 0 to 5 describing how much a person's illness limits daily activity. It is used to estimate prognosis and decide whether someone may tolerate certain cancer treatments; 0 means fully active and 5 means death.

E. Coli

A group of bacteria commonly found in the intestines of people and animals. Most are harmless, but some strains cause diarrhea, urinary infection, or serious illness such as bloodstream infection or kidney injury.

E Coli Enteritis

Infection and inflammation of the intestine caused by disease-producing strains of Escherichia coli. It may cause watery or bloody diarrhea, cramps, vomiting, and dehydration; some strains can injure the kidneys.

E Coli Infection

Infection caused by Escherichia coli bacteria. Depending on the strain and site, it may cause diarrhea, urinary infection, wound or abdominal infection, newborn meningitis, or bloodstream infection; some strains cause kidney injury.

E. coli Infection

Alternate spelling; see *E Coli Infection*.

E. Coli O157:H7

A Shiga toxin-producing strain of Escherichia coli that can cause severe abdominal cramps and bloody diarrhea. In some people, especially young children, infection leads to hemolytic uremic syndrome, a serious complication that can cause kidney failure.

Econazole

A topical antifungal that damages the fungal cell membrane and treats ringworm, athlete's foot, jock itch, and some yeast skin infections. It may cause local irritation, burning, itching, or allergic contact dermatitis.

Economy Class Syndrome

Informal term for venous thromboembolism associated with prolonged sitting during travel, especially deep-vein thrombosis and sometimes pulmonary embolism. It can occur during any long journey, not only air travel.

Ecstasy

A street name for MDMA, an illegal stimulant and hallucinogenic drug. It can cause overheating, dehydration or dangerously low sodium, fast heartbeat, seizures, confusion, liver injury, and death.

Ectasia

Abnormal widening of a blood vessel, duct, tube, or organ. Its importance depends on the structure involved; it may cause pressure, poor flow, bleeding, blockage, or rupture.

Ecthyma

A bacterial skin infection that extends deeper than a superficial sore and causes painful, punched-out ulcers covered by thick crusts. It commonly affects

the legs and may need wound care and antibiotic treatment.

Ecthyma Gangrenosum

A serious skin infection causing rapidly developing dark or black ulcers from tissue death, often due to Pseudomonas bloodstream infection. It occurs mainly in people with severely weakened immunity or very low white-cell counts.

Ectoderm

The outer layer of cells in an early embryo. It develops into the skin, hair, nails, nervous system, eyes, ears, and other sense-related structures.

Ectodermal Dysplasia

A group of inherited disorders affecting tissues such as hair, teeth, nails, skin, and sweat glands. Features may include sparse hair, abnormal teeth, reduced sweating, overheating, dry skin, and repeated infections.

Ectodermal Dysplasias

Plural form; see *Ectodermal Dysplasia*.

Ectodermosis Erosiva Pluriorificialis

Historical name; see *Stevens-Johnson Syndrome*.

Ectomesenchymoma

A rare cancer containing both nerve-related and connective-tissue parts, usually occurring in children. It may appear as a growing mass or cause pain; diagnosis uses tissue examination.

Ectoparasite

A parasite that lives on the outer surface of a host, such as a louse, flea, tick, or mite. It may cause itching, bites, skin disease, anemia, or transmission of infections.

Ectopia Cordis

A rare birth defect in which the heart lies partly or completely outside the chest because the chest wall did not form normally. It is usually life-threatening and associated with major structural abnormalities.

Ectopia Lentis

Displacement of the eye's natural lens from its normal position. Injury or inherited connective-tissue disorders may cause it, leading to blurred or double vision, unequal focusing, or increased eye pressure.

Ectopic

Located or occurring in an abnormal position. For example, an ectopic pregnancy implants outside the main cavity of the uterus, most often in a fallopian tube.

Ectopic ACTH Syndrome

Excess cortisol production caused by a tumor outside the pituitary making adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH). It can cause weight gain, muscle weakness, high blood pressure, diabetes, low potassium, infections, and other features of cortisol excess.

Ectopic Beat

An extra or early heartbeat that starts outside the heart's usual pacemaker. It may feel like a skipped beat, flutter, or thump and can occur in healthy people or with heart disease.

Ectopic Cushing Syndrome

Excess cortisol caused by a tumor outside the pituitary producing ACTH or, rarely, a related hormone. It may cause high blood pressure, diabetes, low potassium, muscle weakness, infections, and rapid physical changes.

Ectopic Heartbeat

Alternate name; see *Ectopic Beat*.

Ectopic Heartbeats

Plural form; see *Ectopic Beat*.

Ectopic Kidney

A kidney located somewhere other than its usual position in the upper back of the abdomen. It may work normally or be associated with abnormal drainage, urine reflux, stones, or infection.

Ectopic Pacemaker

A site outside the sinoatrial node that can initiate a heartbeat. Normally, subsidiary pacemakers can take over if the sinus node fails; an abnormal ectopic focus may produce premature beats or tachycardia.

Alternate Names:
Ectopic Focus

Ectopic Pregnancy

A pregnancy complication in which a fertilized egg implants and begins to grow outside the main cavity of the uterus, most commonly in one of the fallopian tubes. Because structures outside the uterus cannot stretch to accommodate a growing pregnancy, the expanding tissue risks rupturing the fallopian tube, causing severe internal bleeding, sharp abdominal or pelvic pain, dizziness, and fainting. An ectopic pregnancy cannot develop normally into a live birth and requires prompt medical attention.

Alternate Names:
Extrauterine Gestation; Tubal Pregnancy

Ectopic Thyroid

Thyroid tissue located outside its usual position in the lower front of the neck, most often at the base of the tongue. It may be the only functioning thyroid tissue and can cause swallowing, voice, or breathing problems.

Ectopic Thyroid Tissue

Alternate name; see *Ectopic Thyroid*.

Ectopic Tissue

Tissue found outside its usual anatomical location because it developed there, did not move to its usual site during growth, or became implanted there. Examples include thyroid tissue at the base of the tongue and endometrial-like tissue outside the uterus. It may function normally or cause local pain, bleeding, or blockage.

Ectopic Ureter

A ureter that does not enter the bladder in its normal position. It may drain into the urethra, vagina, or another abnormal site and can cause urine leakage, infection, blockage, or kidney damage.

Ectopion

A general term for outward turning of a body structure. In eyelid ectropion, the lid turns away from the eye; in cervical ectropion, glandular cells from the cervical canal are present on the outer surface of the cervix. These are distinct findings.

Ectrodactyly

A birth difference in which one or more central fingers or toes are missing, leaving a deep cleft in the hand or foot. It may occur alone or with other limb or genetic differences and can affect function.

Ectromelia

A birth defect in which one or more limbs are absent or severely underdeveloped. In laboratory medicine, the same word names a mouse poxvirus infection; these are separate uses and should not be confused.

Ectropion

Outward turning of an eyelid, usually the lower lid, so the eye may not close or drain tears normally. It can cause tearing, dryness, irritation, and corneal injury; aging, weakness, scarring, or paralysis may contribute.

Ectropion (Drooping Eyelids)

Misleading label: drooping of the upper eyelid is ptosis, whereas ectropion is outward turning of the eyelid. See *Ptosis*.

Eculizumab

An antibody medicine that blocks part of the immune system called complement. It treats selected blood, kidney, and nerve disorders but greatly increases the risk of meningococcal and other serious infections, so vaccination and monitoring are essential.

Eczema

An umbrella term for inflammatory skin conditions that commonly cause itchy, dry, red, or scaly skin. Some forms also cause blisters, oozing, or cracks. Atopic dermatitis and contact dermatitis are common types; eczema is not contagious.

Eczema Herpeticum

A rapidly spreading herpes simplex infection in skin affected by eczema or another barrier disorder. It causes many similar painful blisters or punched-out sores, often with fever, and can affect the eyes or other organs.

Eczematous Dermatitis

A pattern of inflammatory skin disease characterized by itching, redness, scaling, dryness, oozing, or vesicles. Causes include atopic, allergic contact, irritant contact, and other forms of dermatitis.

ED

Erectile dysfunction, difficulty getting or keeping an erection sufficient for sexual activity. It may reflect blood-vessel, nerve, hormone, medicine, psychological, or relationship factors and can signal broader health problems.

Alternate Names:
Erectile Dysfunction; Impotence

Edema

Swelling caused by extra fluid in body tissues. It may leave a dent when pressed or feel firm. Common causes include heart, kidney, or liver disease, poor vein drainage, blocked lymph flow, and some medicines.

Edema Trunk

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in the soft tissues of the chest or abdomen, producing swelling from heart, kidney, liver, lymphatic, venous, inflammatory, or medication-related causes.

Edentulism

Complete or partial absence of natural teeth. It can impair mastication, speech, nutrition, facial support, and quality of life and may be managed with removable, fixed, or implant-supported prostheses.

Edentulous

Having some or all natural teeth missing. Tooth loss may result from decay, gum disease, injury, extraction, or a developmental condition and can affect chewing, speech, nutrition, jawbone support, and appearance; dentures or implants may restore function.

Edentulousness

Alternate name; see *Edentulism*.

Edetic Acid

Alternate name; see *EDTA*.

EDMD

Abbreviation; see *Emery-Dreifuss Muscular Dystrophy*.

E-D Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome*.

EDTA

Ethylenediaminetetraacetic acid, a chemical that binds metal ions and is used in laboratory testing and some medicines. Calcium disodium edetate is used under specialist supervision to treat lead poisoning; other EDTA salts are not interchangeable and can cause serious harm.

Edwardsiella

A group of bacteria associated with water and animals. Some species, especially E. tarda, can rarely cause diarrhea, wound infection, bloodstream infection, or other illness in people.

Edwardsiella Tarda

A bacterium found in fish, reptiles, and water that can rarely infect people. It may cause diarrhea, wound infection, gallbladder or abdominal infection, or bloodstream infection.

Edward's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Edwards Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
Trisomy 18; Trisomy E

Edwards Syndrome

A chromosome condition caused by an extra chromosome 18 in some or all cells. It commonly causes

poor growth, developmental impairment, feeding difficulty, heart defects, and other birth abnormalities; medical needs and survival vary widely.

Edwards Syndrome (Trisomy 18)

Alternate name; see *Edwards Syndrome*.

EEG

A test that records the brain's electrical activity through sensors placed on the scalp. It helps evaluate seizures, unexplained episodes, altered awareness, certain sleep disorders, and some brain illnesses.

Alternate Names:
Electroencephalogram

EFAST Examination

A rapid bedside ultrasound used after serious injury to look for internal bleeding, fluid around the heart, and air or blood around the lungs. A normal scan does not exclude every internal injury, so repeat assessment or CT may be needed.

Efavirenz

An antiretroviral medicine that blocks HIV reverse transcriptase and is used in combination treatment for HIV infection. It can cause vivid dreams, dizziness, mood or nervous-system effects, rash, and important medicine interactions.

Effacement

Thinning and shortening of the cervix during labor, measured as a percentage from 0 to 100. Effacement helps the cervix open and usually occurs along with dilation as contractions progress.

Effective Dose

An estimate that combines radiation exposure to different organs into one number. It helps compare the approximate risk of imaging procedures but cannot predict an individual person's exact risk.

Effective Half-Life

The time needed for the amount of a radioactive substance in the body or a tissue to fall by half through both natural decay and removal by the body. It helps estimate how long radiation exposure lasts.

Effectiveness

How well a treatment, test, or public-health intervention achieves its intended result in usual real-world practice. It differs from efficacy, which describes performance under ideal, controlled study conditions.

Effective Reproduction Number

The average number of people one infected person infects at a particular time, taking account of immunity, behavior, and control measures. Continued spread generally occurs when the number is above 1.

Alternate Names:
Rt

Effector

A cell, molecule, organ, or mechanism that carries out a response after receiving a signal. For example, an immune cell may destroy an infected cell after activation.

Efferent

Carrying signals away from a central structure. In the nervous system, efferent pathways carry movement or automatic-control signals from the brain or spinal cord to muscles, glands, or organs.

Efferent Arteriole

The small blood vessel that carries blood away from the kidney's filtering unit. It helps control pressure in the filter and leads to the small vessels around the kidney tubules.

Efferent Ductules

A series of 10 to 20 delicate, ciliated convoluted tubules that penetrate the tunica albuginea of the testis to transport spermatozoa from the rete testis into the head (caput) of the epididymis, reabsorbing the majority of testicular luminal fluid.

Alternate Names:

Ductuli Efferentes

Efferent Lymphatic Vessel

A lymphatic vessel that carries lymph out of a lymph node.

Efferent Nerve

A nerve pathway carrying signals away from the brain or spinal cord to muscles, glands, or organs. Damage can cause weakness, impaired automatic function, or loss of control in the affected area.

Efferent Neuron

A nerve cell that carries movement or automatic-control signals from the brain or spinal cord to muscles, glands, or organs. Damage can cause weakness or impaired control of body functions.

Efferent Pathway

A nerve route carrying signals away from the brain or spinal cord to muscles, glands, or organs. It controls movement and automatic functions such as heart rate, digestion, sweating, and bladder activity.

Effervescent Tablets

Tablets dissolved in water before use, releasing bubbles as they form a drinkable solution. Some contain substantial sodium or other ingredients that may affect people with heart, kidney, or blood-pressure conditions.

Efficacy

How well a treatment produces its intended result under ideal, carefully controlled study conditions. It differs from effectiveness, which describes how well the treatment works in ordinary clinical practice.

Effort Angina

A classic presentation of stable ischemic heart disease characterized by substernal chest discomfort, tightness, or pressure predictably provoked by physical exertion, emotional stress, or cold exposure, and consistently relieved within minutes by rest or sublingual nitroglycerin.

Alternate Names:

Classic Angina; Exertional Angina

Effort Syncope

Transient loss of consciousness occurring abruptly during or immediately following physical exertion, serving as a cardinal red-flag symptom of severe cardiac outflow obstruction (such as critical aortic stenosis or hypertrophic obstructive cardiomyopathy) or exertion-induced ventricular arrhythmia.

Effusion

Abnormal buildup of fluid in a body space, such as around a joint, lung, or heart. It may cause swelling, pain, stiffness, or breathing difficulty; the cause may be injury, infection, inflammation, heart failure, or cancer.

Effusive-Constrictive Pericarditis

A form of pericardial disease in which fluid around the heart coexists with constrictive physiology. Signs that the heart remains restricted after the fluid is drained support the diagnosis.

EGD

An examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum using a flexible camera passed through the mouth. It can investigate pain, swallowing problems, bleeding, or anemia and can obtain samples or treat selected lesions.

EGFR

A protein on the cell surface that receives growth signals. Changes that overactivate EGFR can help some cancers grow; testing the tumor may guide use of treatments that block this pathway.

EGFR Inhibition

Cancer treatment that blocks growth signals sent through the epidermal growth factor receptor. It may slow selected colorectal, lung, or head-and-neck cancers when the tumor has suitable features; rash, diarrhea, and other effects may occur.

Egg

A nutrient-rich food containing protein, fat, vita-

mins, and minerals, but also a common allergen. Raw or undercooked eggs can transmit Salmonella; allergy and dietary needs vary.

Egg Allergy

An immune reaction to egg proteins that may cause hives, swelling, vomiting, stomach pain, wheezing, or anaphylaxis. It is more common in children; reactions vary in severity.

Alternate Names:
Egg Hypersensitivity; Hen's Egg Allergy

Egg-Cell

A mature female reproductive cell, also called an oocyte, that can unite with sperm during fertilization. It contains half the usual genetic material and can develop into an embryo after fertilization.

Eggerthella

A group of bacteria that can live in the human intestine without causing disease. Rarely, especially in people with serious illness, they can cause bloodstream infection, abscesses, or other opportunistic infections.

Egg Shell

The hard calcium-containing outer covering of an egg. In medical imaging, "eggshell calcification" describes a thin rim of calcium around a lesion or lymph node.

Eggshell Nail

A nail that becomes unusually thin, soft, flexible, and sometimes pale or concave. Possible causes include nutritional deficiency, chronic illness, aging, or repeated trauma.

Egophony

A change in voice sounds heard through a stethoscope in which a spoken "E" sounds like an "A." It may occur when lung tissue becomes dense or filled with fluid, such as in pneumonia.

EHBA

Abbreviation for extrahepatic biliary atresia, a serious infant disorder in which the bile ducts outside the liver are absent, scarred, or blocked, causing persistent jaundice and progressive liver injury.

Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome

A group of inherited connective-tissue disorders that can cause unusually flexible joints, stretchy or fragile skin, easy bruising, and poor wound healing. Some types also weaken blood vessels or internal organs.

Alternate Names:
EDS

EHR

Electronic health record: a digital collection of a person's health information, such as diagnoses, medicines, allergies, test results, and clinical notes, that can be shared among authorized healthcare professionals.

Ehrlichia

A group of bacteria spread mainly by ticks that infect certain white blood cells and cause ehrlichiosis. Infection may produce fever, headache, muscle aches, low blood counts, and serious illness if untreated.

Ehrlichia And Anaplasma

Tick-borne bacteria that infect white blood cells. They can cause fever, headache, muscle aches, weakness, low blood counts, and abnormal liver tests; severe disease is more likely in older or immunocompromised people.

Ehrlichiosis

A tick-borne infection caused by Ehrlichia bacteria. It commonly causes fever, headache, muscle aches, weakness, low white-cell or platelet counts, and raised liver enzymes; untreated infection can damage the brain, lungs, or other organs.

Ehrlichiosis And Anaplasmosis

Tick-borne bacterial infections that may cause fever, headache, muscle aches, weakness, low blood counts, and abnormal liver tests. Prompt medical assessment and appropriate antibiotics reduce the risk of severe complications.

Eicosanoid

A signaling substance made from certain fats that helps regulate inflammation, blood-vessel width, platelet activity, pain, and muscle contraction. Prostaglandins, leukotrienes, and thromboxanes are examples.

Eicosanoid Degradation

Breakdown and inactivation of eicosanoids, the body's short-lived fatty-acid signals. This limits how long and how strongly they affect inflammation, blood vessels, platelets, airways, and other muscles.

Eicosanoid Metabolism

The body's production, modification, and breakdown of prostaglandins, leukotrienes, thromboxanes, and related fatty-acid signals that influence inflammation, blood vessels, platelets, pain, and airway function.

Eicosanoid Receptor

A protein on or inside a cell that responds to prostaglandins, leukotrienes, thromboxanes, or related lipid signals. Activation can change inflammation, blood-vessel tone, platelet activity, pain, or smooth-muscle contraction.

Eicosapentaenoic Acid

The omega-3 fat EPA, found in oily fish and some supplements. It forms part of cell membranes and can be changed into signaling substances involved in inflammation and blood clotting.

Eicosatetraenoic Acid

A 20-carbon fatty acid with four double bonds. Arachidonic acid is the best-known form and is used by cells to make prostaglandins, leukotrienes, thromboxanes, and other signaling substances.

Eighth Cranial Nerve

The vestibulocochlear nerve, which carries hearing and balance signals from the inner ear to the brain. Its cochlear division carries hearing information, while its vestibular division carries balance information. Damage can affect hearing, balance, or both.

Alternate Names:
Vestibulocochlear Nerve; Auditory Nerve

Eikenella

A group of bacteria found in the mouth. Some species can cause deep wound, bone, joint, or bloodstream infection, especially after human bites or injuries involving a person's teeth.

Eikenella Corrodens

A slow-growing bacterium normally found in the mouth that can cause infection after human bites or clenched-fist injuries. It may produce abscesses, bone or joint infection, or rarely bloodstream infection.

Eisenmenger Complex

Alternate form; see *Eisenmenger Syndrome*.

Eisenmenger's Syndrome

Alternate form; see *Eisenmenger Syndrome*.

Eisenmenger Syndrome

A serious heart condition that develops when a congenital heart defect (such as a large hole between the heart chambers) is left uncorrected. Over time, high blood flow through the lungs causes permanent scarring and high blood pressure in the pulmonary arteries. Eventually, the direction of blood flow across the defect reverses, causing oxygen-poor blood to be pumped out to the body. This leads to chronic cyanosis (a bluish tint to the skin and lips), fatigue, shortness of breath, and clubbing of the fingers.

Alternate Names:
Eisenmenger Complex; Eisenmenger's Syndrome

Ejaculation

The release of semen through the penis, usually during sexual climax. It involves coordinated contractions of reproductive ducts, glands, pelvic muscles, and nerves; pain, blood, or major changes may occur with disorders of the reproductive or urinary tract.

Ejaculatory Duct

One of paired muscular conduits of the male reproductive system formed by the confluence of the ampulla of the vas deferens and the duct of the seminal vesicle near the base of the prostate gland. Measuring approximately 2 cm in length, each ejaculatory duct traverses anteroinferiorly through the substance of the prostate gland and terminates within the prostatic urethra at the verumontanum (seminal colliculus) flanking the prostatic utricle. During emission and ejaculation, coordinated sympathetic contraction delivers spermatozoa and fructose-rich seminal fluid into the urethral lumen; congenital or acquired obstruction of the ducts precipitates obstructive azoospermia, male subfertility, and painful ejaculation, treatable by transurethral resection of the ejaculatory ducts (TURED).

Ejaculatory Ducts

Plural form; see *Ejaculatory Duct*.

Ejaculatory Dysfunction

Difficulty ejaculating, such as delayed ejaculation, absent ejaculation, painful ejaculation, or ejaculation into the bladder instead of out through the penis. Causes include medicines, nerve or pelvic disorders, diabetes, prostate procedures, and psychological factors.

Ejection Click

A sharp heart sound heard just after the heart begins to contract, caused by opening of an abnormal aortic or pulmonary valve. It may occur with a bicuspid valve or valve narrowing and is assessed with other findings.

Ejection Fraction

The percentage of blood pumped out of a heart chamber with each beat. It is used to describe the heart's pumping strength, but a normal value does not rule out heart failure.

Ejection Murmur

A midsystolic crescendo-decrescendo heart murmur that begins shortly after the first heart sound (S1), peaks in midsystole, and ends before the second heart sound (S2), produced by turbulent blood flow across an obstructed or narrowed ventricular outflow tract or semilunar valve, as seen in aortic stenosis and pulmonic stenosis.

Alternate Names:
Systolic Ejection Murmur; Midsystolic Murmur

EKG

Alternate abbreviation; see *Electrocardiogram*.

Ekman-Lobstein Disease

Alternate name; see *Osteogenesis Imperfecta*.

Elastance

A physical and physiological measure of the stiffness and tendency of a hollow organ or vascular structure to recoil toward its original resting dimensions after being distended by pressure, defined mathematically as the change in pressure divided by the change in volume (the inverse of compliance).

Elastic Cartilage

Flexible supporting tissue containing many elastic fibers. It helps structures such as the outer ear, epiglottis, and pressure-equalizing ear tube keep their shape while bending.

Elastic Fiber

A thin connective-tissue fiber that allows skin, lungs, blood vessels, and other structures to stretch and recoil. Damage or loss of elastic fibers can reduce flexibility or weaken tissues.

Elasticity

The ability of a tissue or material to return toward its original shape after stretching or compression. It contributes to the function of skin, lungs, blood vessels, muscles, and ligaments.

Elastics

Elastic bands used in medical or dental care, such as orthodontic bands, compression supports, wound devices, or surgical ties. Their purpose and safe use depend on the specific treatment.

Elastic Skin

Unusually stretchable skin, also called skin hyperextensibility. It can occur in connective-tissue disorders such as some Ehlers-Danlos syndromes, but is not itself a diagnosis of Ehlers-Danlos syndrome.

Elastic Tissue

Connective tissue containing fibers that let structures stretch and return toward their original shape. It helps arteries pulse, lungs expand, skin recoil, and some ligaments support movement.

Elastin

A flexible protein in connective tissue that lets skin, lungs, blood vessels, and other structures stretch and recoil. Aging, inflammation, and chronic sun exposure can damage elastin.

Elastofibroma

A harmless, slowly growing mass made of fatty and elastic tissue, most often beneath the lower shoulder blade in older adults. It may cause swelling or movement-related discomfort but often needs no treatment.

Elastography

An imaging method that estimates how stiff tissue is. It is commonly used to assess liver scarring and may help evaluate breast, thyroid, prostate, or other abnormal areas without tissue removal.

Elastomer

A flexible rubber-like material that can stretch and return toward its original shape. It is used in some medical tubing, seals, gloves, devices, and implants; biocompatibility depends on the material.

Elastosis

Abnormal buildup, breakdown, or alteration of elastic fibers in tissue. It is commonly associated with long-term sun exposure and can occur in some degenerative, inherited, or lung disorders.

Elastosis Perforans Serpiginosa

A rare perforating dermatosis characterized by transepidermal elimination of abnormal elastic fibers, presenting clinically as small, keratotic, umbilicated papules arranged in a serpiginous or annular configuration on the neck, face, or upper extremities, often associated with systemic disorders such as Down syndrome, Ehlers-Danlos syndrome, and pseudoxanthoma elasticum.

Alternate Names:
Lutz Disease

Elbow

The joint connecting the upper arm and forearm, formed by the humerus, radius, and ulna. It allows bending and straightening and works with nearby joints to rotate the forearm.

Elbow Dislocation

Displacement of the radius and ulna from their normal alignment with the humerus, usually after a fall or forceful injury. It causes severe pain, deformity, and loss of motion and may involve nerve, blood-vessel, or bone injury.

Elbow Extensor

A muscle that straightens the elbow, mainly the triceps and anconeus. These muscles help push, reach, lift, throw, and control lowering of the arm.

Elbow Flexors

Muscles that bend the elbow, mainly the biceps, brachialis, and brachioradialis. They help lift the forearm and turn the palm upward; injury, pain, nerve problems, or tendon damage can weaken movement.

Elbow Joint

A joint complex between the humerus, radius, and ulna that allows the arm to bend and straighten and the forearm to rotate. Cartilage, ligaments, muscles, and fluid-filled coverings provide stability and movement.

Elbow Pain

Pain in or around the elbow caused by tendon injury, arthritis, bursitis, nerve pressure, fracture, instability, infection, or referred pain from the neck or

shoulder. Swelling, deformity, weakness, or injury may accompany serious causes.

Alternate Names:
Elbow Arthralgia; Cubital Pain

Elbow (Radial Head or Neck) Fracture

A break in the radial head or neck, the upper end of the radius at the elbow, usually after a fall onto the hand or a direct blow. It can cause pain, swelling, tenderness, and difficulty bending, straightening, or rotating the forearm. Assessment may include X-rays; treatment depends on the fracture and any associated injury, and stable fractures often benefit from early, gentle movement to reduce stiffness.

Alternate Names:
Radial Head or Neck Fracture; Radial Head/Neck Fracture; Radial Neck Fracture

Elbow Replacement

Surgery that removes damaged parts of the elbow and replaces them with artificial components to relieve pain and improve movement. It may be used for severe arthritis or injury; infection, loosening, and nerve or bone problems can occur.

Elder Abuse

An intentional act or failure to provide care that harms an older person. It includes physical, emotional, sexual, or financial abuse and neglect; recognition and safeguarding are shaped by local law.

Elective

Planned in advance rather than performed immediately for an emergency. An elective procedure may still be medically necessary; its timing follows assessment of benefits, risks, alternatives, and the person's preferences.

Elective Abortion

A planned ending of a pregnancy using medicines or a procedure, usually before an immediate medical emergency develops. The method depends on pregnancy duration, health, personal choice, and local clinical and legal requirements.

Elective Surgery

Surgery scheduled in advance because it is not needed immediately to prevent serious harm. It may still be important or medically necessary, and timing follows discussion of benefits, risks, alternatives, and preferences.

Electrical Alternans

A beat-to-beat change in the size or direction of ECG complexes. It can occur when the heart moves within a large fluid collection around it and may indicate cardiac tamponade, an emergency.

Electrical Cardioversion

A controlled electrical shock delivered at a specific point in the heartbeat to restore a normal rhythm, often for atrial fibrillation or flutter. Sedation, clot risk, heart stability, and follow-up treatment must be considered.

Electrical Conductance

The ability of a material or tissue to carry electrical current. It depends on how easily charged particles move and is important in nerve, muscle, heart, and medical-device measurements.

Electrical Injury

Damage caused by electrical current passing through the body. Severity depends on voltage, current, duration, pathway, and skin resistance; effects may include burns, heart-rhythm problems, muscle breakdown, nerve injury, falls, or breathing failure.

Electrical Stimulation

Use of controlled electrical currents to activate nerves or muscles. It may help selected pain, weakness, movement, or rehabilitation problems; benefits and risks depend on the device, body site, and underlying condition.

Electrical Storm

Recurrent sustained ventricular tachycardia or ventricular fibrillation, commonly defined as at least three episodes requiring intervention within 24 hours, including appropriate implantable cardioverter-defibrillator therapies. It is a pattern

of acute cardiac electrical instability.

Alternate Names:
VT/VF Storm; Arrhythmic Storm

Electrical Synapse

A direct connection between cells through tiny channels that let charged particles and electrical signals pass rapidly from one cell to another. It helps coordinate some brain, heart, and other tissue activity.

Electric Axis of the Heart

The net average direction and magnitude of the electrical electromotive forces traveling through the ventricular myocardium during ventricular depolarization, represented on the frontal plane electrocardiogram and normally oriented between -30 degrees and +90 degrees.

Alternate Names:
Mean QRS Axis

Electric Impedance

The opposition a material or tissue offers to alternating electrical current, measured in ohms. Medical devices use impedance changes to assess body composition, monitor signals, or detect contact and function.

Electric Shock

Injury caused when electrical current passes through the body. It can cause burns, muscle damage, falls, abnormal heart rhythms, breathing failure, nerve injury, or internal damage even when skin burns are small.

Electrocardiogram

A test that records the heart's electrical activity through skin electrodes. It helps assess heart rate and rhythm and can show conduction problems or patterns associated with heart disease, a heart attack, or medicine and electrolyte effects.

Alternate Names:
ECG; EKG

Electrocardiographic Gating

An imaging synchronization technique used in cardiac computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and nuclear cardiology that synchronizes image acquisition with specific phases of the patient's cardiac cycle (prospective or retrospective gating) to eliminate cardiac motion artifacts.

Alternate Names:
ECG Gating

Electrocardiography

The process of recording the heart's electrical activity through skin electrodes, usually as a 12-lead ECG. It assesses rate, rhythm, conduction, chamber strain, reduced blood flow, prior injury, and some medicine or electrolyte effects.

Electrocauterization

The use of a heated instrument to destroy tissue or control bleeding. Electricity heats the instrument, but current does not pass through the patient's tissue; this distinguishes electrocauterization from electrosurgery.

Electrocautery

A technique that applies heat from an electrically heated instrument to tissue, usually to destroy a small area or stop bleeding. The current heats the instrument rather than passing through the patient's tissue; the term is often loosely used for electrosurgery.

Electrocoagulation

Coagulation of tissue by heat generated when electrical current passes through it, generally as a mode of electrosurgery. It can seal small blood vessels and control bleeding; it describes a tissue effect rather than one specific instrument.

Electroconvulsive Therapy

A treatment that causes a brief controlled seizure while the person is under general anesthesia. It can rapidly treat severe depression, catatonia, or mania; temporary confusion and memory problems are common risks.

Electrocution

Serious injury or death caused by electrical current

passing through the body. It may produce burns, abnormal heart rhythms, muscle or nerve damage, breathing failure, falls, or hidden internal injury.

Electrode

A conductive contact that carries electrical signals or current to or from the body, a device, or a laboratory sample. Electrodes are used in tests such as ECG and EEG and in selected treatments.

Electrodessication

A procedure using electrical energy to dry and destroy selected superficial tissue or control bleeding. It may treat some skin lesions, often with scraping, and can cause pain, scarring, infection, or pigment change.

Electroencephalogram

A recording of brain electrical activity through scalp electrodes. It helps evaluate seizures, prolonged altered awareness, encephalopathy, selected sleep disorders, and some intensive-care conditions; a normal result does not exclude epilepsy.

Electroencephalography

The process of recording brain electrical activity with electrodes on the scalp. It can help identify abnormal patterns associated with seizures, sleep disorders, or diffuse brain dysfunction.

Electrogastrogram

A recording of the stomach's electrical activity, usually through electrodes on the abdominal skin. It measures stomach rhythm and is used mainly in specialist assessment of suspected motility disorders.

Electrolysis

Hair removal using electrical energy delivered through a fine probe into individual hair follicles. Repeated treatment may permanently reduce hair growth, but pain, irritation, pigment changes, scarring, or infection can occur.

Electrolyte

An essential mineral—such as sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, or chloride—that carries an electric charge when dissolved in body fluids like blood. Electrolytes are vital for transmitting nerve impulses, contracting muscles, maintaining proper fluid balance, and regulating the body's acid-base balance.

Alternate Names:
Electrolytes; Serum Electrolytes

Electrolyte Balance

Maintenance of appropriate levels of minerals such as sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, chloride, and phosphate in body fluids. The kidneys, hormones, intestines, and lungs regulate them; imbalance can affect nerves, muscles, heart rhythm, and hydration.

Electrolyte Disorders

Disorders involving abnormal concentrations or distribution of sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, chloride, phosphate, or bicarbonate in body fluids. They may result from kidney, endocrine, gastrointestinal, cardiac, or critical-illness conditions and can affect neuromuscular function, consciousness, and cardiac rhythm.

Electrolyte Imbalance

An abnormal level of minerals such as sodium, potassium, calcium, magnesium, chloride, or phosphate in the blood. It may cause weakness, cramps, confusion, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms; causes include fluid loss, kidney disease, medicines, and hormone disorders.

Electrolyte Panel

A blood test measuring selected electrolytes, commonly sodium, potassium, chloride, and bicarbonate, and sometimes related minerals. It helps assess fluid balance, kidney function, acid-base disorders, and causes of weakness or confusion.

Electrolytes

Plural form; see *Electrolyte*.

Electromagnetic Navigation

Bronchoscopy

A computer-guided form of bronchoscopy that helps a flexible camera reach small areas near the outer lung. It can guide a biopsy of a lesion not visible with ordinary bronchoscopy, but bleeding, infection, or a collapsed lung can occur.

Electromechanical Dissociation

A cardiac arrest in which the monitor shows electrical activity but the heart does not pump enough blood to produce a pulse. Resuscitation and treatment of the underlying cause may restore circulation.

Alternate Names:
EMD; Pulseless Electrical Activity; PEA

Electromyography

A test (EMG) that records electrical activity in skeletal muscles at rest and during contraction, usually with a needle electrode. It helps assess muscle disorders and problems affecting the nerves that control muscles, including nerves near the spine and the connection between nerves and muscles. It is often done with nerve-conduction studies, which measure how signals travel along nerves.

Electron-Beam Computed Tomography

A rapid CT technique that uses an electronically steered X-ray beam to image the heart and measure calcium deposits in coronary arteries. It has largely been replaced by newer CT methods.

Alternate Names:
EBCT

Electronic Cigarette

A battery-powered device that heats liquid into an inhaled aerosol, often containing nicotine and other chemicals. It can cause dependence, airway irritation, lung injury, or poisoning from liquid nicotine and is not harmless.

Electronic Fetal Monitoring

Continuous or intermittent recording of the fetal heart rate and uterine contractions during pregnancy or labor. The heart-rate pattern provides an indirect measure of fetal well-being and can signal possible oxygen-related stress; it does not measure fetal oxygen directly.

Electron Microscope

A microscope that uses electrons rather than visible light to produce highly magnified images of cells, tissues, microorganisms, or materials.

Electron Transport Chain

A series of protein systems inside mitochondria that transfer energy from nutrients to oxygen and use it to make ATP, the cell's main energy source. Problems in this process can impair organs that need substantial energy, such as the brain and muscles.

Electronystagmography

A test that records eye movements with sensors around the eyes, often while the balance system is stimulated. It helps evaluate involuntary eye movements and inner-ear or balance-nerve disorders; video testing is now often preferred.

Electrophoresis

A laboratory method that separates charged molecules by how they move through a gel or liquid in an electric field. It can analyze proteins, hemoglobin, DNA, and other substances.

Electrophysiological Study

An invasive cardiac test in which catheters record and stimulate electrical activity inside the heart to diagnose arrhythmias and assess their origin and response to selected interventions.

Electrophysiologic Testing

Testing that records or deliberately stimulates the heart's electrical system, usually with catheters, to investigate abnormal rhythms and guide treatment. It is invasive and carries risks such as bleeding, infection, or rhythm disturbance.

Electrophysiology

The study of electrical activity in living cells and tissues. Clinical electrophysiology includes tests and treatments involving heart rhythm, nerves, muscles,

and the connections between them.

Electrophysiology Study

An invasive test in which thin electrode catheters are placed in the heart to map electrical pathways and trigger or measure abnormal rhythms. It can guide ablation or other treatment; bleeding, infection, and rhythm complications are possible.

Electroretinography

A test that records the retina's electrical response to flashes or patterned light. It helps evaluate inherited or acquired retinal disorders when examination and imaging do not fully explain visual loss.

Electrosurgery

Use of electrical energy during a procedure to cut tissue, destroy tissue, or control bleeding. Risks include burns, scarring, smoke exposure, unintended tissue injury, and interference with implanted electronic devices.

Electrosurgical Unit

A generator that delivers high-frequency electrical energy through an electrode to cut tissue or stop bleeding. Safe use requires attention to current pathways, burns, nearby structures, and possible interference with implanted electronic devices.

Elejalde Syndrome

A very rare autosomal-recessive neurocutaneous disorder characterized by silvery or gray hair, abnormal melanin distribution, and severe neurologic disease such as seizures, hypotonia, and developmental impairment. It requires specialist genetic and neurologic evaluation.

Element

A pure substance made of atoms with the same number of protons. Some elements, such as iron and iodine, are essential nutrients; others can be toxic, and health effects depend on dose and exposure.

Elephant Ear Poisoning

Irritation or poisoning after eating or handling elephant-ear or taro plants, which contain sharp calcium-oxalate crystals. It can cause intense burning and swelling of the mouth and throat and may obstruct breathing.

Elephantiasic Pretibial Myxedema

A rare, severe form of Graves dermopathy (pretibial myxedema) with marked lymphedema and multiple nodular, polypoid, or warty lesions, usually on the lower legs and feet. It can cause pronounced limb enlargement and may occur despite normal or low thyroid hormone levels.

Alternate Names:
Elephantiasic Pretibial Myxoedema

Elephantiasis

Severe, long-lasting swelling and thickening of skin, usually in a limb or the scrotum, caused by blocked lymph drainage. Lymphatic filariasis is one cause; other causes include repeated infection, surgery, cancer, or injury.

Elevated Blood Pressure

Blood pressure readings that are repeatedly above the healthy range. Persistent elevation increases the risk of heart disease, stroke, kidney disease, and blood-vessel problems, although a single high reading does not establish a diagnosis.

Elevated Hemidiaphragm

An imaging finding in which one side of the diaphragm sits higher than usual. Causes include reduced lung volume, nerve or muscle weakness, abdominal disease, or a normal variation; significance depends on symptoms and other findings.

Elevated Liver Enzymes

Abnormal blood levels of enzymes measured in liver tests, including ALT, AST, alkaline phosphatase, or GGT. ALT and AST elevations often reflect hepatocellular injury, while alkaline phosphatase and GGT may suggest cholestasis. AST and alkaline phosphatase can also rise from nonhepatic sources.

Elevation

Upward movement or position of a body part, such

as raising the arm, shoulder, jaw, or foot. The term can also describe raising an injured limb to reduce swelling.

Elevator

A surgical or dental instrument used to lift, separate, or loosen tissue, bone, or a tooth from nearby structures. The exact design and use depend on the procedure.

Eligible

Meeting the requirements for a treatment, clinical trial, screening program, benefit, or healthcare service. Eligibility does not guarantee that an intervention is appropriate or that it will be available.

Elimination

Removal of waste products or medicines from the body, mainly through the kidneys, liver, lungs, skin, or intestines. Reduced elimination can make a medicine remain longer in the body and increase its effects or toxicity.

Elimination Diets

Short-term eating plans that remove suspected foods and later reintroduce them in a planned way to identify food-related symptoms. They should be supervised when many foods are excluded or nutrition could be compromised.

Alternate Names:
Exclusion Diet; Diagnostic Elimination Diet

Elimination Disorders

A group of childhood-onset disorders involving inappropriate urination or defecation, including enuresis and encopresis. These disorders are diagnosed in a developmentally inappropriate context and are distinguished from incontinence caused by a known medical, neurologic, structural, infectious, or substance-related condition.

Elimination Half-Life

The time required for the amount of a medicine in the blood to fall by half. It helps guide dosing intervals and predicts accumulation and clearance; kidney or liver disease, age, and interactions can change it.

Elimination Patterns

The timing, frequency, amount, and appearance of urination and bowel movements. Changes can provide clues about hydration, kidney or bowel function, continence, infection, bleeding, or other illness.

ELISA Blood Test

A blood test that uses an enzyme-linked reaction to detect or measure an antibody, antigen, hormone, protein, or other substance. Results depend on the test design, timing, sample, and likelihood of disease before testing.

Elixir

A sweetened liquid preparation, historically sometimes containing alcohol, used to carry a medicine. The exact ingredients and strength determine its medical effects, interactions, and poisoning risk.

Elizabethkingia

A group of environmental bacteria that can rarely cause severe infection, especially in newborns, older adults, or people with weakened immunity. Illness may involve the blood, lungs, brain, or other organs.

Elliptocyte Count

The number or proportion of oval or elongated red blood cells on a blood smear. A high proportion can occur in hereditary elliptocytosis; elliptocytes may also appear in iron-deficiency anemia.

Elliptocytosis

A condition in which many red blood cells are oval or elongated rather than round. Inherited forms may cause red cells to break down early and produce anemia, while some people have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Ovalocytosis

Ellis-Van Creveld Syndrome

An inherited skeletal condition causing short limbs, extra fingers or toes, a narrow chest, and abnormal teeth or nails. Congenital heart disease is com-

mon and may affect breathing, growth, or physical function.

Ellsworth-Howard Test

A specialized test of how the kidneys respond to parathyroid hormone. It measures changes in urine after the hormone is given and may help distinguish pseudohypoparathyroidism from other causes of low parathyroid hormone effects.

Alternate Names:
PTH Responsiveness Test; Parathyroid Hormone Infusion Test

Elongin

A protein complex that helps RNA polymerase II continue copying genetic information into RNA. It contributes to gene regulation and cell function and is mainly a molecular-biology term.

Elotuzumab

An antibody medicine that helps the immune system recognize and attack myeloma cells. It is used with other medicines for selected multiple-myeloma patients and can cause infusion reactions, infection, fatigue, or low blood counts.

Eltrombopag

An oral medicine that stimulates the thrombopoietin receptor in bone marrow and increases platelet production. It is used for selected low-platelet conditions and can affect the liver, clotting risk, or blood counts.

Eltrombopag Olamine

The salt form of eltrombopag, an oral medicine that increases platelet production in selected blood disorders. Liver tests, blood counts, medicine interactions, and clotting risk may require monitoring.

Emaciation

Extreme loss of body weight, muscle, and fat caused by severe malnutrition, chronic disease, cancer, infection, or other illness. It can weaken immunity and function; causes and nutritional needs vary.

Embolectomy

Removal of a traveling blood clot or other blockage from a blood vessel with surgery or a catheter procedure to restore blood flow. It may be urgent when a limb or organ is threatened.

Alternate Names:
Arterial Embolectomy; Surgical Embolectomy

Emboli

Plural form of embolus; see *Embolus*.

Embolic Stroke

A stroke caused by a clot or other material traveling to and blocking an artery that supplies the brain. Emergency treatment may restore blood flow and limit permanent brain injury.

Alternate Names:
Brain Embolism Cerebral Embolism

Embolic Stroke of Undetermined Source

A non-lacunar ischemic stroke detected on neuroimaging without proximal arterial stenosis exceeding 50 percent, a major cardioembolic source (such as atrial fibrillation), or other established specific cause despite comprehensive diagnostic evaluation.

Alternate Names:
ESUS

Embolism

Blockage of a blood vessel by material that traveled through the bloodstream from another site. The material is most often a clot but may be fat, air, infected material, or rarely tumor tissue.

Embolization

Deliberate blockage of a blood vessel or abnormal vessel connection using a catheter and materials such as coils, particles, or plugs. It can control bleeding, reduce tumor blood flow, or treat selected aneurysms and malformations.

Embolization Therapy

An image-guided procedure that blocks selected blood vessels with coils, particles, plugs, or other materials. It can control bleeding, reduce blood sup-

ply to a tumor, treat aneurysms, or close abnormal vessel connections.

Embolus

Material traveling through the bloodstream that may lodge in a smaller vessel and block it. It may be a blood clot, fat, air bubble, infected material, or rarely tumor tissue.

Embryo

A developing human from fertilization through the end of the eighth week after fertilization. From the ninth week until birth, the developing human is called a fetus.

Embryogenesis

The process by which an embryo develops after fertilization through cell division, movement, specialization, and formation of organs and body structures.

Embryo Grading

A visual assessment of an embryo created during in vitro fertilization, based on features such as cell number and appearance or, at the blastocyst stage, its expansion and the appearance of its inner cell mass and outer cell layer. The grade helps compare embryos, but it does not test chromosomes or guarantee implantation or pregnancy.

Embryology

The study of development from fertilization through the embryonic and fetal stages, including how organs and body structures form, grow, and become specialized.

Embryoma

A rare tumor made of primitive cells resembling early embryonic tissue. The term can refer to different tumor types, so diagnosis depends on the organ involved and microscopic examination.

Embryonal Carcinoma

An aggressive germ-cell tumor composed of primitive malignant cells, occurring in the testis, ovary, or other sites and often treated with chemotherapy and surgery.

Embryonal CNS Tumor

A highly cellular malignant pediatric CNS tumor with primitive or embryonal morphology. Diagnosis depends on integrated histologic and molecular classification, and treatment usually combines surgery, radiation when appropriate, and chemotherapy.

Embryonal Rhabdomyosarcoma

A malignant skeletal-muscle-lineage tumor that commonly affects young children and may arise in the head and neck, urinary tract, or reproductive tract.

Embryonal Tumors

Cancers that arise from cells resembling developing embryonic tissue, often occurring in children and commonly affecting the nervous system.

Embryo Neoplasm

A tumor arising from primitive cells resembling developing embryonic tissue, usually in a child. Diagnosis and treatment depend on the tissue of origin, microscopic and molecular features, location, and spread.

Embryonic

Relating to an embryo, the developing human or animal during the early period after fertilization. In humans, the embryonic period ends at about eight weeks after fertilization, followed by the fetal period.

Embryonic Cell

A cell of an early embryo capable of division and differentiation into specialized tissues; embryonic stem cells have broad developmental potential.

Embryonic Development

The biological process of cellular proliferation, organogenesis, and morphogenesis occurring from fertilization through the eighth gestational week; see *Embryogenesis*.

Embryonic Induction

A developmental process in which one group of embryonic cells signals nearby cells to develop into a particular tissue or structure.

Embryonic Mosaic

A developing embryo containing two or more groups of cells with different genetic makeups, produced by a change after fertilization. Effects depend on the cells involved and the proportion of each cell group.

Embryonic Stage

The early developmental period after fertilization during which the basic body plan and major organs begin to form. In human pregnancy it lasts through about eight weeks after fertilization.

Embryo Transfer

A fertility procedure in which one or more laboratory-grown embryos are placed into the uterus through a thin catheter. It may be done soon after fertilization or after freezing and thawing; implantation and pregnancy are not guaranteed.

Alternate Names:
ET; Intrauterine Embryo Transfer

Emergence Agitation

Temporary confusion, restlessness, fear, or inconsolable crying while waking from anesthesia. It is more common in children and usually resolves with reassurance and monitoring, but pain, low oxygen, or another complication must be excluded.

Emergency Airway Puncture

An emergency procedure that creates an airway through the neck when severe upper-airway blockage prevents breathing and a breathing tube cannot be placed. It is a temporary, high-risk lifesaving measure performed only by trained professionals.

Emergency Care

Immediate assessment and treatment for a serious or time-sensitive illness or injury. Clinicians first protect breathing, circulation, brain function, and control of bleeding, pain, or infection, then arrange continued treatment or transfer.

Emergency Code

A hospital alert that summons a designated response to an urgent event, such as cardiac arrest, fire, or security threat. The meaning of each code varies by institution.

Emergency Contraception

Birth control used after unprotected sex or contraceptive failure to reduce the chance of pregnancy. Options include an oral medicine or copper intrauterine device; effectiveness depends mainly on the method and how soon it is used.

Emergency Department

The hospital service that evaluates and treats sudden illness and injury. Staff prioritize people by seriousness, stabilize life-threatening problems, diagnose causes, provide initial treatment, and arrange discharge, admission, or transfer.

Emergency Medicine

The medical specialty for rapid assessment and initial treatment of sudden illness and injury at any age. It includes resuscitation, stabilization, diagnostic evaluation, urgent procedures, and coordination of disposition or transfer across emergency and hospital settings.

Alternate Names:
A&E Medicine

Emergency Procedures

Planned actions for responding safely to urgent events such as cardiac arrest, airway blockage, contamination, equipment failure, or radiation exposure while protecting patients, staff, and the public.

Emerging Infectious Disease

An infection that is newly recognized, has recently increased, or is spreading into a new population or region. Causes may include animal-to-human transmission, genetic change, travel, climate, or loss of effective control.

Emery-Dreifuss Muscular Dystrophy

A rare inherited muscle disease causing early tightness around the elbows, ankles, and neck followed by slowly progressive weakness. Heart conduction problems, abnormal rhythms, and cardiomyopathy may occur, so regular heart monitoring is essential.

Emesis

Forceful emptying of stomach contents through the mouth, commonly called vomiting. It may result from infection, medicines, poisoning, pregnancy, blockage, brain disease, or other illness and can cause dehydration.

Emetic

A pharmacological or chemical agent that stimulates vomiting (emesis) by acting either locally on gastric mucosal sensory receptors (e.g., syrup of ipecac) or centrally on the chemoreceptor trigger zone (CTZ) within the area postrema of the medulla oblongata via dopamine D_2, serotonin 5-HT_3, or neurokinin-1 (NK_1) receptors (e.g., apomorphine). Once widely utilized in initial toxicological management, the clinical use of emetics has been almost entirely abandoned in contemporary emergency medicine because emesis fails to reliably reduce toxin absorption, delays the administration of activated charcoal, and markedly increases the risks of aspiration pneumonia, esophageal rupture (Boerhaave syndrome), and chemical pneumonitis.

Alternate Names:
Emetics; Vomiting Inducer

Emetics

Plural form; see *Emetic*.

EMG

A test that records electrical activity in muscles, usually with nerve-conduction testing. It helps investigate weakness, numbness, nerve injury, trapped nerves, muscle disease, and disorders of the nerve-muscle connection.

Alternate Names:
Electromyography

Eminentia

An anatomical term for a raised or prominent part of a body structure. It may provide attachment for a muscle or ligament, form part of a joint, or serve as a landmark during examination or surgery.

Emission

The discharge or release of a substance, usually a fluid. In male reproduction, emission is the movement of semen into the urethra before ejaculation.

Emmenagogue

A substance traditionally claimed to start or increase menstrual bleeding. Evidence and safety vary, and some products can cause poisoning, miscarriage, or interactions; missed or abnormal periods can have many causes.

Emmetropia

The usual focusing state of the eye in which incoming parallel light focuses on the retina without extra effort. Nearsightedness, farsightedness, or astigmatism causes light to focus away from the retina.

Emodin

A plant chemical studied for laxative, anti-inflammatory, and anticancer effects. Evidence and safety are not established for routine treatment, and concentrated products may cause diarrhea, dehydration, or medicine interactions.

Emollient

A substance applied to skin to soften and moisturize it, reduce water loss, and strengthen the protective barrier. Emollients are commonly used for dry skin and eczema; greasy products can make floors or clothing slippery.

Emotion

A feeling state involving subjective experience, brain and body responses, behavior, and interpretation of events. Emotions are normal, but persistent or extreme changes may occur with mental or physical illness.

Emotional Adjustment

The process of adapting thoughts, feelings, and behavior to illness, loss, stress, or a major life change. Difficulty adjusting may cause persistent distress or impaired functioning and may benefit from support or treatment.

Emotional Blunting

A reduced capacity to experience and express subjective emotions, characterized by diminished feelings of joy, sadness, affection, or enthusiasm; commonly encountered in major depression, schizophrenia, or as a medication side effect.

Emotional Dependency

Reliance on another person for reassurance, self-worth, or emotional stability to a degree that limits independence or causes distress. It is not a diagnosis by itself and may reflect anxiety, low self-esteem, trauma, or relationship difficulties.

Emotional Disorders

Mental-health conditions involving persistent or severe changes in mood or emotional responses that cause distress or interfere with daily life, relationships, school, or work. Examples include depressive, anxiety, and trauma-related disorders.

Emotional Dysregulation

Impaired ability to modulate, manage, or tolerate emotional responses, leading to exaggerated mood fluctuations, emotional instability, or impulsive reactions out of proportion to situational triggers; see *Emotional Dysregulation Disorder*.

Emotional Dysregulation Disorder

A nonstandard term for persistent difficulty regulating emotional responses. Emotional dysregulation can occur in several mental-health and neurologic conditions, including borderline personality disorder, but is not itself a specific diagnosis.

Emotional Eating

Eating in response to stress, boredom, sadness, anger, or other feelings rather than mainly physical hunger. Occasional emotional eating is common, but frequent episodes can affect health and may benefit from behavioral or psychological support.

Emotional Lability

Rapid, exaggerated, and unpredictable shifts in mood or emotional expression (such as sudden unprovoked crying or laughing) out of proportion to the circumstances; see *Pseudobulbar Affect*.

Empathy

The ability to understand another person's feelings and point of view. It supports respectful communication and compassionate care but does not require agreeing with the person or experiencing the same feelings.

Emphysema

A type of chronic obstructive pulmonary disease in which air sacs are permanently damaged and enlarged, reducing air exchange. Smoking is a common cause; breathlessness, cough, and reduced exercise capacity may develop gradually.

Emphysematous Aortitis

A rare, life-threatening infection of the aortic wall that produces gas within the artery, usually caused by organisms such as *Clostridium septicum*. It may cause severe back or abdominal pain, sepsis, bleeding, or an abnormal connection with the intestine.

Emphysematous Cholecystitis

A severe gallbladder infection in which gas-forming bacteria produce gas in the gallbladder wall or cavity. It is more common in people with diabetes and can rapidly cause tissue death, perforation, or sepsis.

Emphysematous Gastritis

A rare, severe infection in which gas-forming germs invade the stomach wall. It can cause sudden abdominal pain, fever, bleeding, or sepsis and is a dangerous form of gas in the stomach wall, unlike some milder causes of gastric pneumatosis.

Emphysematous Hepatitis

A rare, life-threatening gas-forming infection of liver

tissue, usually caused by bacteria in people with diabetes or weakened immunity. It can cause fever, abdominal pain, sepsis, and liver failure.

Emphysematous Prostatitis

A rare, severe prostate infection in which gas-forming bacteria produce gas within prostate tissue. It may cause fever, pelvic or perineal pain, difficulty urinating, urinary retention, and sepsis.

Emphysematous Pyelonephritis

A severe kidney infection in which gas-forming bacteria destroy kidney tissue. It occurs mainly in people with diabetes and can cause fever, flank pain, shock, and sepsis; urgent drainage, antibiotics, and sometimes surgery are needed.

Empirical

Based on observation, measurement, or experience rather than theory alone. Empirical treatment begins before the exact cause is confirmed and is revised when test results or the clinical course provide more information.

Empirical Treatment

Treatment started on the basis of symptoms and likely causes before a diagnosis is confirmed. It may be revised when test results or the response to treatment becomes available.

Empiric Antibiotic Therapy

Starting an antibiotic before the exact germ and its medicine sensitivity are known. The first choice is based on the symptoms, likely source of infection, local resistance patterns, and the person's health; it may be changed when test results return.

Empiric Risk

An estimate of the probability of a specified outcome, calculated from observed rates in a defined population. The estimate applies to the outcome and population studied; it may not predict an individual's risk if that person differs in relevant ways.

Employee

A person who works for an employer under an agreement. In occupational health, assessment may consider workplace exposures, safety, physical or mental function, and ability to perform duties safely.

Empty Calories

A nontechnical term for foods or drinks that provide energy but little protein, fiber, vitamins, or minerals, such as many sugary drinks and highly processed snacks. Frequent intake can displace more nutritious foods.

Empty Can Test

A shoulder examination maneuver that assesses the supraspinatus muscle and tendon. With the arm raised in the scapular plane and the thumb pointing down, the examiner applies downward pressure as the person resists. Pain or weakness may suggest rotator-cuff disease but does not establish a diagnosis by itself.

Alternate Names:
Jobe Test; Supraspinatus Test

Empty Nose Syndrome

A poorly understood condition that can follow surgery on the nasal turbinates, the structures that warm and moisten air. The nose may feel blocked or too open despite a clear airway; dryness, crusting, and a reduced sense of airflow may also occur. Examination may not show a physical blockage.

Empty Sella Syndrome

A condition in which fluid presses the pituitary gland flat within its bony space. It is often found incidentally and causes no symptoms, but some people have headaches, vision problems, or reduced pituitary-hormone production.

Empyema

The presence of pus in a body cavity or hollow organ. In common clinical use, it most often refers to pleural empyema: pus in the space between the lung and chest wall, usually associated with pneumonia or another infection. Empyema can also occur in other spaces, including the gallbladder or subdural

space.

Empyema Necessitans

Alternate spelling; see *Empyema Necessitatis*.

Empyema Necessitatis

Spread of a pleural empyema through the parietal pleura and chest wall into nearby soft tissues, where it can form an abscess or draining sinus. It is an uncommon complication of pleural infection, classically associated with tuberculosis or actinomycosis, but other bacteria and fungi can also cause it.

Alternate Names:
Empyema Necessitans

EMR

Electronic medical record: a digital record of health information maintained within a particular healthcare organization or practice. It may include diagnoses, notes, medicines, allergies, test results, and treatment plans.

Emtricitabine

An antiretroviral medicine that blocks HIV reverse transcriptase and is used with other medicines to treat or prevent HIV infection. Kidney function and hepatitis B status are important because stopping it can worsen hepatitis B.

Emulsion

A mixture of two liquids that normally do not blend, such as oil and water, with one dispersed in the other. Emulsions are used in some medicines, nutrition products, cosmetics, and laboratory preparations.

Enalapril

A medicine that blocks formation of angiotensin II, relaxing blood vessels and reducing strain on the heart. It treats high blood pressure and heart failure but can cause cough, high potassium, kidney problems, or rarely facial swelling.

Enalaprilat

The active injectable form related to enalapril that blocks angiotensin II formation and lowers blood pressure. It is used in selected settings and can cause low blood pressure, high potassium, kidney problems, or facial swelling.

Enamel

The hard, mineral-rich outer covering of a tooth crown. It protects the sensitive inner tooth but cannot repair itself after major damage; acids and bacteria can cause erosion and decay.

Enamel Hypoplasia

Incomplete formation of tooth enamel while a tooth is developing, leaving it thin, grooved, pitted, or discolored. Affected teeth are more vulnerable to sensitivity, wear, and decay.

Enamel Organ

The developing tissue of a tooth that produces enamel and helps shape the crown. It is present during tooth formation and later contributes to the protective covering around the developing tooth.

Enamel Pearl

A small lump of enamel on a tooth root, often near where the roots divide. It can make cleaning difficult and interfere with gum attachment, increasing the risk of localized gum disease.

Enanthem

A rash, spot, ulcer, or other lesion on a mucous membrane, especially inside the mouth. It may occur with infection, inflammation, an allergic or medicine reaction, or a systemic illness.

Enanthema

A rash or lesion on a moist membrane lining the mouth, throat, genitals, or another body surface. Infection, inflammation, medicines, or systemic disease may cause it.

Enarthrosis

A ball-and-socket joint that allows movement in many directions, including bending, straightening, rotation, and movement away from or toward the body. The hip and shoulder are examples.

Encapsulated

Enclosed by a capsule or clearly defined layer of tissue. This may describe a cyst, growth, infection, or organ; being encapsulated does not by itself prove that a lesion is harmless or cancerous.

Encapsulated Peritoneal Sclerosis

Alternate name; see *Encapsulating Peritoneal Sclerosis*.

Alternate Names:
Sclerosing Encapsulating Peritonitis; EPS

Encapsulating Peritoneal Sclerosis

A rare condition in which thick scar tissue surrounds the intestines and can cause repeated blockage, pain, vomiting, and poor nutrition. It is most associated with long-term peritoneal dialysis but can have other causes.

En Caul Birth

A delivery in which the baby is born completely enclosed within the intact amniotic sac. It can occur during vaginal or cesarean delivery and differs from a caul birth, in which only part of the membrane remains over the newborn.

Encephalitis

Inflammation of brain tissue, often caused by an infection or an abnormal immune reaction. It may cause fever, headache, confusion, seizures, behavior change, weakness, or movement problems and can progress rapidly.

Encephalitis Lethargica

A rare inflammatory brain disorder described mainly during the early twentieth century, causing sleepiness, abnormal movements, eye-movement problems, and other neurologic symptoms. Its cause remains uncertain.

Encephalitis Virus

A virus capable of infecting the brain and causing encephalitis. It may spread through mosquitoes, ticks, animals, respiratory secretions, food, or other routes depending on the virus.

Encephalitozoon

A group of tiny spore-forming parasites that can infect the intestine, eyes, kidneys, or several organs. Serious disease occurs mainly in people with weakened immunity.

Encephalocele

A birth defect in which the coverings of the brain and sometimes brain tissue protrude through an opening in the skull. It may cause a visible head swelling and can be associated with seizures, fluid buildup, developmental problems, or other brain abnormalities.

Encephalofacial Angiomatosis

Sturge-Weber syndrome, a congenital neurocutaneous disorder involving capillary malformations of the face and leptomeninges. It may cause seizures, glaucoma, stroke-like episodes, headaches, and developmental or visual problems.

Encephalomalacia

Softening or loss of brain tissue after injury, stroke, bleeding, infection, or reduced blood flow. The resulting permanent damage may cause seizures, weakness, movement problems, memory changes, or other neurologic effects.

Encephalomyelitis

Inflammation affecting both the brain and spinal cord, caused by infection or an abnormal immune response. It may cause confusion, seizures, weakness, numbness, balance problems, or bladder changes and requires urgent neurologic assessment.

Encephalopathy

A disorder that broadly affects brain function, causing confusion, drowsiness, personality change, difficulty thinking, or coma. Causes include infection, toxins, organ failure, medicines, metabolic problems, seizures, and reduced oxygen.

Encephalotrigeminal Angiomatosis

A birth condition involving abnormal blood vessels in the skin of the face and the coverings of the brain. It may cause a port-wine stain, seizures, weakness,

learning problems, or glaucoma, but symptoms vary.

Alternate Names:
Sturge-Weber Syndrome; SWS

Enchondroma

A usually harmless cartilage growth inside a bone, often in the hands or long bones and found by chance. Pain, enlargement, fracture, or unusual imaging features can overlap with a more serious tumor.

Enchondromatosis

A disorder in which multiple cartilage growths develop inside bones. It can cause uneven growth, limb deformity, pain, or fractures; a small number of lesions may become cancerous and require monitoring.

Encoding

The process by which sensory or other information is changed into a form the brain can store in memory. Attention, sleep, stress, illness, and brain injury can affect encoding.

Encopresis

Repeated passage of stool in inappropriate places by a child at an age or developmental level when bowel control is expected. It is often related to long-term constipation and retained stool but may have other medical, developmental, or emotional contributors.

Endangiitis

Inflammation of the inner lining of a blood vessel. Swelling or scarring can thicken the lining, narrow the vessel, and reduce blood flow.

Endarterectomy

Surgery that removes fatty plaque and diseased inner lining from an artery to improve blood flow, most often a carotid artery in the neck. Possible complications include bleeding, stroke, heart attack, or nerve injury.

Endarteritis

Inflammation of the inner lining of an artery that can narrow the vessel and reduce blood flow. Causes include infection, autoimmune disease, injury, and other vascular disorders.

Endemic

Regular presence of a disease or infectious agent in a particular population or region at an expected baseline level. Endemic does not mean that every person is infected or that cases cannot increase.

Endemic Diseases

Diseases that remain present at a predictable level in a particular population or region. Their frequency is shaped by local environment, immunity, behavior, exposures, healthcare access, and prevention measures.

Endemic Fungi

Fungi naturally found in particular geographic regions whose spores can cause infection when inhaled. Disease may affect the lungs and sometimes spread to other organs, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Endemic Goiter

Thyroid enlargement occurring commonly in a population, traditionally because of insufficient iodine intake. It may occur with normal, low, or high thyroid function depending on the cause.

Endergonic

Describing a chemical reaction that requires an input of energy. In cells, energy from food or another reaction drives processes such as building proteins, DNA, or other complex molecules.

Ending Pregnancy With Medicines

Ending a pregnancy with prescribed medicines that cause the uterus to empty. The appropriate method depends on pregnancy duration, health, symptoms, and local clinical requirements; follow-up confirms completion and checks for complications.

Endobronchial Foreign Body

An object lodged in a bronchus, partly or completely

blocking an airway. It may cause sudden coughing, one-sided wheezing, collapse of part of the lung, or pneumonia and often requires urgent bronchoscopy for removal.

Endobronchial Tumor

A growth inside a bronchus that can narrow the airway and cause cough, wheezing, coughing blood, lung collapse, or repeated pneumonia. It may be benign or cancerous; diagnosis usually requires imaging and tissue sampling.

Endobronchial Ultrasound

A procedure combining bronchoscopy with ultrasound to examine structures beside the airways and guide needle sampling of lymph nodes or masses. It is commonly used to diagnose and stage lung cancer and other chest diseases.

Endobronchial Valve

A one-way valve placed through a bronchoscope into a selected airway to reduce air trapping in severe emphysema. It lets air and mucus leave but limits new air entering; pneumothorax and infection are possible complications.

Endocannabinoid

A signaling molecule made naturally by the body that activates cannabinoid receptors. Endocannabinoids help regulate pain, appetite, mood, memory, movement, and immune activity.

Endocardial Cushion Defect

Alternate name; see *Atrioventricular Septal Defect*.

Endocardial Fibroelastosis

Thickening of the inner lining of the heart from excess fibrous and elastic tissue, usually in infants or children. It can stiffen the heart or weaken its pumping and may lead to heart failure.

Endocarditis

An infection or inflammation of the endocardium, the smooth inner lining of the heart's chambers and valves. It most often occurs when bacteria or other germs from elsewhere in the body (such as the mouth or skin) enter the bloodstream and attach to damaged or artificial heart valves. Symptoms may include fever, chills, fatigue, heart murmurs, shortness of breath, and small spots or bleeding under the nails or skin.

Alternate Names:
Infective Endocarditis; Bacterial Endocarditis

Endocarditis Prophylaxis

Preventive antibiotics given before selected dental procedures to people at highest risk of serious infective endocarditis complications. They are not needed for everyone; eligibility depends on the heart condition and procedure.

Endocarditis Surgical Indications

Reasons surgery may be needed for endocarditis include heart failure from valve damage, uncontrolled infection or abscess, infection of a prosthetic valve, fungal infection, or a high risk of emboli. Decisions require a specialist heart team.

Endocardium

The thin inner lining of the heart chambers and valves. It provides a smooth surface for blood flow and continues into the inner lining of blood vessels; inflammation or infection can damage it.

Endocervical

Relating to the inner canal or lining of the cervix, the lower part of the uterus that connects the uterine cavity with the vagina.

Endocervical Culture

A laboratory test that attempts to grow bacteria or fungi from a sample collected from the inner cervix. It may help investigate cervicitis or selected infections, although molecular tests are preferred for many sexually transmitted infections.

Endocervical Gram Stain

A microscope test that stains cells and organisms from the inner cervix. It may show inflammation or some bacteria but cannot by itself reliably diagnose every sexually transmitted infection.

Endocrine

Relating to hormones released into the bloodstream by glands or specialized cells. Endocrine organs include the thyroid, pituitary, adrenal glands, pancreas, and reproductive glands.

Endocrine Disease

A disorder of a hormone-producing gland or hormone action. It may affect growth, metabolism, reproduction, stress responses, blood pressure, or fluid and electrolyte balance.

Endocrine Disorders

Diseases in which hormone-producing glands make too much or too little hormone, or the body does not respond to hormones properly. They may affect growth, metabolism, reproduction, mood, blood pressure, and fluid balance. Examples include thyrotoxicosis, hypothyroidism, hypogonadism, Cushing syndrome, and Addison's disease.

Endocrine Disrupting Chemicals

Chemicals that can interfere with hormone production, transport, breakdown, or action. Some exposures are associated with reproductive, developmental, thyroid, metabolic, or cancer outcomes, but risk depends on the substance, dose, and timing.

Endocrine Disruptor

A chemical that interferes with hormone systems. Possible effects include altered development, reproduction, thyroid function, or metabolism; health risk depends on the chemical, exposure level, duration, and timing.

Endocrine Finding

A symptom, examination result, imaging result, or laboratory result that may suggest abnormal hormone production, hormone action, or an endocrine-gland disorder.

Endocrine Function

The production, release, transport, and action of hormones that regulate metabolism, growth, reproduction, stress responses, blood pressure, and fluid or electrolyte balance.

Endocrine Gland

An organ or group of cells that releases hormones into the bloodstream, without using ducts to carry those hormones. They travel to target cells and regulate functions such as metabolism, growth, reproduction, stress responses, and fluid balance. Examples include the pituitary, thyroid, parathyroid, adrenal, and pineal glands, and hormone-secreting tissue in the pancreas and gonads.

Endocrine Glands

Plural form; see *Endocrine Gland*.

Endocrine Hypertension

High blood pressure caused by excess or abnormal hormone activity. Causes include primary aldosteronism, excess cortisol, or excess adrenaline-like hormones from an adrenal or related tumor.

Endocrine Myopathies

Muscle disorders caused by hormonal disease, such as thyroid, adrenal, parathyroid, or pituitary dysfunction. Weakness, exercise intolerance, cramps, or muscle pain may improve when the underlying endocrine disorder is treated.

Endocrine Neoplasm

A benign or cancerous growth arising in a hormone-producing gland or cell. It may release too much hormone or cause symptoms by pressing on nearby structures; evaluation depends on its location and behavior.

Endocrine Pancreas

The hormone-producing part of the pancreas, made mainly of pancreatic islets. Its cells release insulin, glucagon, somatostatin, and other hormones that help regulate blood glucose and digestion.

Endocrine System

The network of glands and hormone-producing cells and tissues that release chemical messengers into the blood. It includes structures such as the hypothalamus, pituitary, thyroid, parathyroids, adrenal glands, pancreatic islets, and gonads; its hormones regulate growth, metabolism, reproduction, stress

responses, sleep, blood pressure, fluid balance, and other aspects of homeostasis.

Endocrine Testing

Blood, urine, saliva, stimulation, suppression, and sometimes imaging tests used to assess hormone production and action. Results depend on timing, medicines, age, sex, illness, and the test method.

Endocrine Therapy

Treatment that lowers, blocks, or changes hormone signals to control hormone-sensitive cancer. It may be used for breast, prostate, or other cancers; effects depend on the medicine and can include hot flashes, sexual changes, or bone loss.

Endocrine Tissues

Cells or groups of cells that produce and release hormones into the bloodstream or nearby tissues. They are found in glands and in organs such as the pancreas, ovaries, testes, kidneys, and intestine.

Endocrinologist

A physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of hormones, endocrine glands, and metabolism, including diabetes, thyroid disease, adrenal disease, osteoporosis, and reproductive hormone problems.

Endocrinologists

Plural form; see *Endocrinologist*.

Endocrinology

The medical specialty concerned with hormones, endocrine glands, and metabolism. It includes diabetes and disorders of the pituitary, thyroid, and adrenal glands, as well as problems involving growth, reproduction, bone, and fluid or electrolyte balance.

Endocrinopathy

A disorder of an endocrine gland or hormone system that causes too much, too little, or abnormal hormone action. Effects depend on the hormone and may involve growth, metabolism, reproduction, mood, or fluid balance.

Endocytosis

The process by which a cell folds its outer membrane around material and brings it inside in a small sac. Cells use it to absorb nutrients, remove particles, and control surface signals.

Endoderm

The innermost of the three early embryonic cell layers. It develops into the linings of the digestive and respiratory systems and contributes to organs such as the liver, pancreas, thyroid, and bladder.

Endodontics

The dental specialty concerned with the soft tissue inside teeth, root canals, and tissues around tooth roots. Endodontists diagnose and treat tooth infection, inflammation, injury, and related pain.

Endodontist

A dentist with advanced training in diagnosing and treating disease or injury of the tooth's inner tissue, root canals, and tissues around tooth roots. They commonly perform complex root-canal treatment.

End-Of-Life Care

Care for a person nearing death that focuses on comfort, symptom relief, dignity, communication, and personal goals. It also supports family and caregivers and may include hospice or palliative services.

Endogenous

Originating within the body or produced by its own cells or tissues, rather than introduced from outside. Endogenous hormones, chemicals, infections, or substances may be contrasted with external sources.

Endogenous Biomarker

A measurable characteristic produced within the body that indicates a normal biological process, disease process, exposure, or response to an intervention. Examples include naturally occurring metabolites or proteins measured in blood or urine; results may also be affected by factors unrelated to the process being assessed.

Alternate Names:
Endogenous Biomarkers

Endogenous Cushing Syndrome

Hypercortisolism caused by internal overproduction of cortisol or its stimulatory hormones, including pituitary, adrenal, or ectopic sources. Features may include central weight gain, hypertension, diabetes, proximal weakness, bruising, and bone loss.

Endogenous Opiates

Older term for endogenous opioids; see *Endogenous Opioids*.

Endogenous Opioids

Opioid-like peptides made naturally by the body, including endorphins, enkephalins, and dynorphins. They activate opioid receptors to influence pain, stress, mood, reward, movement, and hormone regulation.

Alternate Names:
Endogenous Opioid Peptides

Endogenous Retrovirus

A piece of viral DNA inherited in the human genome from an ancient virus that infected a reproductive cell. Most such sequences are inactive, although some can influence gene control or normal development.

Endoleak

Continued blood flow into the weakened part of an artery after endovascular aneurysm repair. Some types indicate an inadequate seal or device problem and may require repair; others are monitored according to sac growth and risk.

Endolimax

A group of amoebas that can live in the intestine. They are usually harmless colonizers rather than causes of disease; significance of a stool finding depends on symptoms and other test results.

Endolimax Nana

An amoeba that can live harmlessly in the intestine and appear in stool tests. It usually does not cause illness; its presence may indicate exposure to contaminated food or water and should not alone explain digestive symptoms.

Endolymph

Fluid inside the membranous part of the inner ear that helps sensory organs detect sound and head movement. Abnormal pressure or composition can contribute to dizziness, hearing changes, or ringing.

Endolymphatic Hydrops

Abnormal buildup or expansion of endolymph-filled spaces in the inner ear. It is associated with Ménière disease but does not by itself establish the diagnosis or fully explain its cause.

Alternate Names:
Meniere Hydrops; Inner Ear Hydrops

Endometrial

Relating to the endometrium, the inner lining of the uterus. This lining changes during the menstrual cycle and can support implantation of a pregnancy; abnormal growth may cause bleeding or affect fertility.

Endometrial Ablation

A procedure that destroys much of the uterine lining to reduce heavy menstrual bleeding. It is not contraception, pregnancy afterward can be dangerous, and it is generally intended for people who do not plan future pregnancy.

Endometrial Adenocarcinoma

A gland-forming cancer of the uterine lining. It often causes abnormal bleeding, especially after menopause; treatment depends on the cancer's type, grade, stage, molecular features, and overall health.

Endometrial Atrophy

Thinning of the uterine lining, often after menopause when estrogen levels fall. The lining may become fragile and cause light vaginal bleeding or spotting. It is one possible cause of bleeding after menopause, but that bleeding can also have other causes, including endometrial cancer.

Endometrial Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of the uterine lining for laboratory examination, often to investigate abnormal bleeding or suspected overgrowth or cancer. Cramping and light bleeding are common; occasionally the sample is insufficient for diagnosis.

Endometrial Cancer

Cancer arising from the inner lining of the uterus. Abnormal bleeding—especially after menopause—is a common warning sign; evaluation usually includes examination, imaging, and a sample of the uterine lining.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Endometrial Neoplasm; Endometrial Carcinoma

Endometrial Carcinoma

Cancer arising from the uterine lining, often causing abnormal bleeding, particularly after menopause. Diagnosis requires examination of uterine-lining tissue, and treatment depends on type and spread.

Endometrial Disorder

Any condition affecting the uterine lining, including inflammation, polyps, abnormal overgrowth, endometriosis-related changes, or cancer. It may cause heavy or irregular bleeding, pelvic pain, infertility, or no symptoms.

Endometrial Hyperplasia

Overgrowth of glands in the uterine lining, often after prolonged estrogen exposure without enough progesterone. It may cause heavy, irregular, or postmenopausal bleeding. It is classified as hyperplasia without atypia or atypical hyperplasia, also called endometrial intraepithelial neoplasia (EIN). Hyperplasia without atypia is not precancer; atypical hyperplasia/EIN is precancerous and can sometimes be found alongside endometrial cancer, so it needs prompt evaluation.

Endometrial Implants

Lesions of tissue resembling the uterine lining that grow outside the uterus in endometriosis. They may cause local inflammation, scarring, or adhesions; see *Endometriosis*.

Endometrial Intraepithelial Neoplasia

A precancerous overgrowth of abnormal glands in the uterine lining. It can exist with or progress to endometrial cancer, so treatment may involve removal of the uterus or hormone treatment when preserving fertility is important.

Alternate Names:
EIN; Atypical Endometrial Hyperplasia

Endometrial Intraepithelial Neoplasia (EIN)

Alternate name; see *Endometrial Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Endometrial Neoplasm

An abnormal growth of the uterine lining that may be benign, precancerous, or cancerous. Symptoms, tissue examination, imaging, and—if cancer is present—stage determine treatment.

Endometrial Polyp

Alternate name; see *Uterine Polyp*.

Endometrial Polyps

Alternate name; see *Uterine Polyp*.

Endometrial Receptivity Analysis

A test that examines activity of genes in a sample of the uterine lining to estimate when it may best support embryo implantation. Its ability to improve pregnancy rates is uncertain, so results need specialist interpretation.

Alternate Names:
ERA; Endometrial Receptivity Assay

Endometrial Stromal Nodule

A rare, usually harmless, well-defined growth of connective-tissue cells in the uterus. It differs from cancer by not invading nearby tissue or blood vessels, but microscopic examination is needed for reliable classification.

Endometrial Stromal Sarcoma

A rare cancer arising from connective-tissue cells of the uterine lining. Some forms grow slowly and others aggressively; abnormal bleeding or pelvic symptoms may occur, and treatment depends on grade, spread, hormone receptors, and molecular findings.

Alternate Names:
ESS

Endometrioid Carcinoma Of The Vulva

A rare gland-forming cancer of the vulvar skin or nearby tissue that resembles cancer of the uterine lining. Diagnosis requires tissue examination and confirmation that it did not spread from the uterus or ovary.

Endometrioid Ovarian Carcinoma

A type of ovarian cancer whose cells resemble glands of the uterine lining. It may be associated with endometriosis; symptoms, treatment, and outlook depend on stage, grade, and tumor features.

Endometrioma

An ovarian cyst caused by endometriosis in which old blood collects. It may cause pelvic pain, painful periods, pain during sex, or infertility, although some people have no symptoms.

Endometriosis

A chronic gynecological condition in which tissue similar to the lining of the uterus (endometrium) grows outside the uterus, most commonly on the ovaries, fallopian tubes, and pelvic surfaces. Like normal uterine tissue, these misplaced patches thicken, break down, and bleed with each menstrual cycle, but because the blood has no way to exit the body, it causes chronic inflammation, scarring, pelvic pain (especially during periods), and potential fertility challenges.

Alternate Names:
Pelvic Endometriosis

Endometritis

Inflammation or infection of the uterine lining, often after childbirth, miscarriage, abortion, or a procedure entering the uterus. It may cause fever, pelvic pain, tenderness, abnormal discharge, or bleeding and needs treatment.

Endometrium

The inner lining of the uterus. It thickens each month under hormone control to prepare for pregnancy and sheds during menstruation; abnormal thickening, inflammation, polyps, or cancer can cause bleeding or fertility problems.

Endomyocardial Biopsy

A procedure that removes tiny samples from the heart muscle through a catheter in a vein. The samples can help check for rejection after a heart transplant or investigate some heart-muscle diseases.

Alternate Names:
EMB

Endomyocardial Fibrosis

Scarring and thickening of the inner heart lining and nearby muscle that makes the heart stiff and reduces filling. It can cause breathlessness, swelling, abnormal rhythms, or heart failure.

Endomysium

A delicate layer of reticular connective tissue that individually invests each single skeletal muscle fiber, containing an intricate network of capillaries and nerve terminals essential for metabolic exchange and muscle contraction.

Endoneurium

A delicate layer of loose connective tissue and collagen fibrils that directly surrounds each individual myelinated or unmyelinated axon and its accompanying Schwann cell sheath within a peripheral nerve fascicle.

Endoparasite

A parasite that lives inside its host, such as a worm in the intestine or a microscopic parasite in blood or tissue. It may cause no symptoms or lead to inflammation, anemia, organ damage, or infection.

Endopeptidase

An enzyme that cuts proteins or peptides at internal points rather than removing amino acids only from an end. Digestive enzymes such as pepsin and trypsin are examples.

Endophthalmitis

A severe infection inside the eye involving its tissues or fluids, most often after surgery, an injection, or an injury; infection can also spread from elsewhere in the body. It can rapidly damage vision.

Endoplasmic Reticulum

A network of tiny membrane-lined spaces inside cells. It helps make and transport proteins and fats, stores calcium, and processes substances needed for cell structure and function.

Endoprosthesis

An artificial device placed inside the body to replace, support, or restore a body structure. Examples include joint replacements, vascular grafts or stents, and some devices used to keep an airway open.

Endoribonuclease

An enzyme that cuts RNA at internal chemical bonds. It helps process RNA into usable forms or break down RNA that is damaged, unnecessary, or produced by viruses.

Endorphin

A natural chemical made by the body that acts on opioid receptors in the brain and other tissues. It can reduce the feeling of pain and influence stress, mood, and other body responses.

Endorphins

Plural form; see *Endorphin*.

Endoscope

A flexible or rigid instrument with a light and camera used to view an internal body passage or cavity. It can sometimes collect tissue, stop bleeding, remove growths, or perform other treatments.

Endoscopic Endonasal Surgery

A minimally invasive operation performed through the nostrils and nasal passages using an endoscope, commonly to reach selected skull-base, pituitary, sinus, or nearby lesions. Risks include bleeding, infection, cerebrospinal-fluid leak, and injury to nearby structures.

Endoscopic Mucosal Resection

An endoscopic procedure that removes a superficial growth from the digestive tract after lifting it away from deeper tissue. The removed tissue is examined to determine whether it was completely removed and whether cancer is present.

Endoscopic Retrograde Cholangiopancreatography

A procedure combining an endoscope and X-ray imaging to examine and treat the bile and pancreatic ducts. It can remove stones, open narrowed ducts, place stents, or obtain samples; pancreatitis, bleeding, and infection are possible risks.

Endoscopic Submucosal Dissection

An endoscopic procedure that removes a larger or flatter superficial growth from the digestive tract in one piece by dissecting beneath it. It allows detailed tissue examination but carries risks of bleeding and perforation.

Endoscopic Third Ventriculostomy

A brain procedure used to treat some types of hydrocephalus, in which fluid builds up because its normal path is blocked. A small camera is used to make an opening in one of the brain's fluid spaces so the fluid can drain. It may reduce the need for a shunt, but not everyone is a suitable candidate and the opening can close later.

Alternate Names:
ETV; Third Ventriculostomy; Endoscopic Ventriculostomy

Endoscopic Thoracic Sympathectomy

A minimally invasive operation that interrupts selected nerves in the chest, usually for severe sweating of the hands. Possible complications include

increased sweating elsewhere, drooping eyelid, collapsed lung, nerve injury, and heart or blood-pressure changes.

Endoscopic Ultrasound

A procedure combining an endoscope with ultrasound to view the digestive-tract wall and nearby organs. It can guide needle sampling of lymph nodes, pancreas, or other masses and help assess the depth or spread of disease.

Endoscopy

Examination of an internal body passage or cavity with a camera-equipped instrument. Depending on the site, it can directly inspect tissue, collect samples, remove growths, widen narrow areas, or stop bleeding.

Endosome

A small membrane-bound compartment inside a cell that receives material taken in from the cell surface and sorts it for recycling, transport, or breakdown.

Endosteum

A thin membrane lining the inner surfaces of bones, including the marrow cavity and small internal channels. It contains cells involved in bone formation, remodeling, and repair.

Endostosis

Abnormal formation of bone on or within an existing bone. It may be a localized developmental finding or part of a broader bone disorder; the significance depends on its location, extent, and symptoms.

Endothelial

Relating to the thin layer of cells lining blood and lymphatic vessels and some internal surfaces. These cells help control blood flow, vessel leakiness, inflammation, clotting, and new-vessel growth.

Endothelial Cell

A cell lining a blood or lymphatic vessel. It regulates movement between blood and tissues and helps control vessel widening, inflammation, clotting, and formation of new blood vessels.

Endothelial Nitric Oxide Synthase

A calcium- and calmodulin-dependent enzyme constitutively expressed in vascular endothelial cells that synthesizes nitric oxide from L-arginine, mediating basal vasodilation, inhibition of leukocyte adhesion, and suppression of platelet aggregation.

Alternate Names:
eNOS; NOS3

Endothelin

A small protein made mainly by cells lining blood vessels that strongly narrows vessels and affects blood pressure, circulation, inflammation, and tissue growth. Excess signaling contributes to some cases of pulmonary arterial hypertension.

Endothelin Receptor Antagonists

Medicines that block signals that narrow blood vessels, especially in the lungs. They are used for selected pulmonary arterial hypertension; liver injury, anemia, swelling, and serious fetal harm are important risks.

Endothelium

The thin layer of specialized cells lining blood and lymphatic vessels. It controls exchange between blood and tissues and helps regulate vessel diameter, inflammation, clotting, and new-vessel growth.

Endothelium-Derived Relaxing Factor

A substance released by vessel-lining cells that relaxes blood vessels. It is largely identified with nitric oxide, which also helps reduce platelet sticking and vessel-wall inflammation.

Alternate Names:
EDRF

Endotoxin

A component of the outer membrane of certain bacteria, especially Gram-negative bacteria. When released into the body, it can trigger fever, inflammation, low blood pressure, organ injury, and life-threatening sepsis.

Endotracheal Intubation

Placement of a breathing tube through the mouth or nose into the windpipe to keep the airway open, deliver ventilator support, give anesthetic gases, or protect the lungs. Incorrect placement can cause severe harm and must be confirmed.

Endotracheal Tube

A breathing tube passed through the mouth or nose into the windpipe to maintain an airway and support ventilation. An inflatable cuff may seal the airway; irritation, injury, infection, or incorrect placement can occur.

Endourologist

A urologist specializing in minimally invasive procedures performed through the urinary tract or small access sites. Common work includes treating urinary stones, narrowing, blockage, and selected tumors.

Endovaginal Ultrasound

Ultrasound imaging performed with a covered probe placed gently in the vagina to examine the uterus, uterine lining, ovaries, cervix, and early pregnancy. It uses sound waves rather than radiation and may cause temporary discomfort.

Endovascular

Located inside a blood vessel or performed from within it, usually with a catheter passed through a small skin puncture. Endovascular procedures can treat aneurysms, clots, narrowing, bleeding, or abnormal vessels.

Endovascular Aneurysm Repair

Alternate name; see *Endovascular Aortic Aneurysm Repair*.

Endovascular Aortic Aneurysm Repair

Repair of an aortic aneurysm by placing a fabric-covered stent graft inside the aorta through a catheter, usually passed through an artery in the groin. The graft diverts blood flow away from the weakened area and lowers rupture risk. Abdominal and thoracic repairs are commonly called EVAR and TEVAR, respectively.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Aortic Repair

Endovascular Coiling

A catheter procedure that treats some brain aneurysms from inside the blood vessels, without opening the skull. A clinician guides soft metal coils into the aneurysm, where they promote clotting and reduce blood flow into it. The procedure can lower the risk of bleeding, but the aneurysm may need follow-up imaging or further treatment.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Aneurysm Coiling; Guglielmi Detachable Coiling; GDC; Aneurysm Embolization Coils

Endovascular Embolization

A catheter procedure that deliberately blocks a selected blood vessel using coils, particles, plugs, or another material. It may control bleeding or treat an aneurysm, malformation, or tumor blood supply; non-target blockage is a possible risk.

Endovascular Graft

A fabric-covered artificial tube placed inside a diseased blood vessel through a catheter. It can reinforce a weak artery or exclude an aneurysm; suitability and follow-up depend on anatomy, symptoms, and imaging.

Endovascular Repair

A minimally invasive procedure that uses a catheter-delivered graft, balloon, stent, or other device to repair a blood vessel from inside. Bleeding, clotting, infection, leakage, or need for further treatment can occur.

Endovenous Laser Ablation

A treatment for some varicose veins in which a thin laser fiber is placed inside the vein through a small needle opening. Heat closes the treated vein, and blood flows through healthier veins. It is usually done with local numbing medicine; bruising, pain, clots, nerve irritation, or return of the vein can occur.

Alternate Names:
EVLA; Endovenous Laser Therapy; EVLT; Endove-

nous Thermal Ablation

End Point

A predefined outcome or measurement used to judge a clinical study, treatment, diagnostic test, or disease process. It may be a symptom, laboratory result, event, survival measure, or patient-reported outcome.

End Stage

The advanced phase of a disease in which normal function is severely impaired. Meaning, criteria, expected course, and treatment options depend on the disease, such as advanced kidney, liver, lung, or heart failure.

End-Stage Kidney Disease

Advanced chronic kidney disease in which the kidneys can no longer adequately remove waste or control fluid, electrolytes, and acid levels. Treatment options include dialysis, kidney transplantation, or supportive care based on health and preferences.

End-Stage Renal Disease

The most advanced stage of chronic kidney disease, usually when kidney filtration is below 15 or dialysis is needed. Waste and fluid can accumulate, causing nausea, itching, confusion, swelling, anemia, or heart complications.

Alternate Names:
ESRD

Endurance

The ability to continue physical or mental activity without becoming tired quickly. It depends on heart and lung function, muscle conditioning, energy, sleep, and overall health and can be assessed with activity or exercise tests.

Enema

Introduction of liquid into the rectum through the anus to soften stool, stimulate bowel emptying, deliver selected treatment, or assist a test. Overuse can cause irritation, dehydration, or electrolyte problems.

Energy

The capacity needed for body functions, movement, growth, and temperature control, obtained mainly from food. Persistent low energy may reflect poor sleep, inadequate nutrition, anemia, hormone disease, mood disorder, infection, or another illness.

Energy Conservation

Strategies that reduce unnecessary effort and fatigue during daily activities, such as planning, pacing, prioritizing, resting, sitting for tasks, changing position, and using helpful equipment.

Energy Expenditure

The energy the body uses for basic functions, movement, digestion, growth, pregnancy, and temperature control. It varies with body size, muscle mass, age, activity, illness, and other conditions.

Energy Increased

A noticeable rise in energy or activity. It may be normal, but unusually high energy with little need for sleep, racing thoughts, impulsive behavior, or irritability can occur with stimulant use, thyroid disease, mania, or hypomania.

Energy Intake

The amount of energy obtained from food and drink, usually measured in calories. Appropriate intake depends on age, body size, activity, illness, pregnancy, and nutritional goals.

Energy Metabolism

The chemical processes that convert nutrients into usable energy for cells. They include breaking down carbohydrates, fats, and proteins and storing or using the resulting energy for body functions.

Energy Resolution

The ability of a radiation detector to distinguish radiation particles with different energies. Better resolution allows more accurate identification and separation of radioactive substances during imaging or laboratory measurement.

Energy Window

The range of radiation energies accepted by a detector or gamma camera to create an image. Choosing it appropriately improves image quality by accepting desired signals and reducing scattered radiation.

Enfuvirtide

An injectable HIV medicine that blocks fusion of HIV with human immune cells. It is used with other antiretroviral medicines for resistant infection; injection-site reactions and allergic reactions can occur.

Engagement

Descent of the widest part of the baby's presenting head or body into the parent's pelvis. It may occur before labor or during labor and indicates that the baby has entered the birth passage.

Enhanced Elimination

Medical methods used to remove an absorbed poison more quickly, such as dialysis or changing urine chemistry. They are used only for selected toxins because benefits, timing, and risks depend on the substance and the person's condition.

Enhanced Pause

A calculated breathing index, abbreviated Penh, derived from airflow measurements during whole-body plethysmography, mainly in laboratory animals. It has been used as an indirect indicator of airway narrowing, but it does not directly measure airway resistance and its interpretation is debated.

Enhanced Recovery After Surgery

A coordinated care plan before, during, and after surgery that supports recovery through education, appropriate nutrition and fasting, pain control, early movement, early eating, and prevention of complications.

Enhancement Artifact

An imaging effect in which tissue behind a fluid-filled or low-density structure appears brighter than it really is, especially on ultrasound. It is a technical artifact, not necessarily a sign of increased blood flow or tissue density.

Enhancer

A stretch of DNA that increases activity of a gene when regulatory proteins bind to it. It may be far from the gene and can work in either direction, helping control when and where the gene is active.

Enkephalin

A natural opioid-like peptide made by the body that activates mainly delta and mu opioid receptors. It helps regulate pain, stress, mood, movement, and other nervous-system functions.

Enlarged Adenoids

Overgrowth of immune tissue behind the nose that can block nasal breathing and cause mouth breathing, snoring, repeated ear-fluid problems, or sleep-disordered breathing. Symptoms and age determine whether treatment is needed.

Enlarged Fontanelle

A soft spot on an infant's skull that is significantly larger than normal for age, which may be associated with conditions such as congenital hypothyroidism, rickets, skeletal dysplasias, or increased intracranial pressure.

Alternate Names:
Large Fontanelle

Enlarged Heart

An increase in heart size caused by conditions such as high blood pressure, valve disease, heart-muscle disease, anemia, or athletic adaptation. It may cause no symptoms or lead to breathlessness, swelling, rhythm problems, or heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Cardiomegaly

Enlarged Liver

Alternate name; see *Hepatomegaly*.

Alternate Names:
Hepatomegaly; Hepatic Enlargement

Enlarged Prostate

An increase in prostate size, also called prostatomegaly. Benign prostatic hyperplasia is a common cause, but inflammation and prostate cancer can also enlarge the gland.

Enlarged Spleen

Increase in spleen size caused by infection, liver or blood disease, inflammation, cancer, or congestion. It may cause fullness or pain and can increase rupture risk; evaluation considers symptoms, blood counts, and the underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Splenomegaly; Splenic Enlargement

Enophthalmos

Abnormal backward sinking of an eyeball within the eye socket. It may follow injury, loss of tissue around the eye, dehydration, aging, or a nerve disorder and can cause unequal eye appearance or double vision.

Enoxaparin

A low-molecular-weight heparin that reduces clotting by enhancing antithrombin activity, especially against factor Xa. It prevents or treats blood clots but can cause bleeding, low platelets, or injection-site bruising.

Enrichment

Adding nutrients to food after processing has removed some of them. Enriched flour, for example, commonly has certain B vitamins and iron added back to help prevent nutritional deficiencies.

Entamoeba

A group of single-celled amoebas that live in the intestine or other tissues. Some species are harmless, while Entamoeba histolytica can cause diarrhea, intestinal ulcers, or liver abscesses.

Entamoeba Coli

A usually harmless amoeba found in the human intestine and spread by fecal contamination. Its presence in stool indicates exposure to contaminated food or water but usually does not cause illness.

Entamoeba Hartmanni

A small, usually harmless intestinal amoeba spread through fecal contamination. It generally causes no disease; identification in stool mainly indicates possible exposure to contaminated food, water, or hands.

Entamoeba Histolytica

A parasite spread when contaminated food, water, or hands are swallowed. It can cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, and bloody stools and may invade the intestine or spread to the liver, causing an abscess.

Entamoeba Polecki

An intestinal amoeba that can infect people after fecal contamination, often through contact with animals or contaminated food and water. It is usually harmless but may occasionally be associated with diarrhea.

Enteral

Relating to or delivered through the digestive tract. Enteral nutrition provides food and fluids by mouth or through a feeding tube into the stomach or intestine.

Enteral Formula

A liquid nutrition preparation given by mouth or feeding tube. It may provide complete nutrition or selected nutrients and is chosen according to digestion, absorption, fluid needs, kidney or liver disease, and metabolic requirements.

Enteral Nutrition

Delivery of food, fluids, and nutrients through the digestive tract, by mouth or feeding tube. It may be used when swallowing or eating is unsafe or inadequate; aspiration, diarrhea, blockage, and tube displacement are possible complications.

Enteric

Relating to the intestine or digestive tract. The term can also describe organisms, infections, medicines, or coatings associated with the intestines.

Enteric Bacteria

Bacteria that live in or affect the intestinal tract. Some are harmless normal residents, while others cause diarrhea or infections outside the intestine, such as urinary, wound, or bloodstream infection.

Enteric-Coated

Covered with a protective layer that resists stomach acid and dissolves in the small intestine. This can protect the stomach or protect a medicine from stomach acid; such tablets should not usually be crushed.

Enteric Duplication Cyst

A birth-related cyst attached to or within the digestive tract, most often the small intestine. It may cause pain, blockage, bleeding, infection, or no symptoms and can require surgery.

Enteric Fever

A systemic infection caused by *Salmonella* enterica serotypes Typhi or Paratyphi, usually spread through food or water contaminated with human feces. It causes prolonged fever and may include headache, abdominal pain, weakness, diarrhea or constipation, and sometimes a rash. Severe disease can cause intestinal bleeding or perforation.

Enteric Nervous System

The network of nerve cells within the digestive tract that helps control movement, secretion, blood flow, and communication with the brain and spinal cord.

Enteritis

Inflammation of the small intestine caused by infection, inflammatory disease, radiation, reduced blood flow, medicines, or other injury. It may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, vomiting, fever, bleeding, or dehydration.

Enterobacter

A group of Gram-negative bacteria that may live in the intestine but can cause healthcare-associated urinary, bloodstream, wound, respiratory, or abdominal infection, especially in vulnerable people.

Enterobacter Aerogenes

Former taxonomic name; see *Klebsiella Aerogenes*.

Enterobacter Cloacae

A Gram-negative bacterium that can cause healthcare-associated urinary, bloodstream, lung, wound, or abdominal infection. It may resist several antibiotics, so laboratory susceptibility testing guides treatment.

Enterobacter Hormaechei

A bacterium in the Enterobacter cloacae group that can cause opportunistic healthcare-associated infection of blood, urine, lungs, wounds, or devices. Testing for antibiotic resistance is often important.

Enterobacteriaceae

A family of Gram-negative bacteria that includes Escherichia, Klebsiella, Enterobacter, Salmonella, and Shigella. Some normally live in the intestine, while others cause intestinal, urinary, wound, or bloodstream infection.

Enterobacteriaceae Carbapenem Resistance

Resistance in certain Gram-negative bacteria to carbapenem antibiotics, often caused by enzymes that destroy these medicines. Such infections can be difficult to treat and require laboratory testing, infection control, and specialist guidance.

Enterobiasis

Infection with pinworms, small intestinal worms whose eggs spread easily between people. It commonly causes intense itching around the anus at night, disturbed sleep, and sometimes irritation in the genital area.

Enterobius

A group of pinworms that live in the intestine. Enterobius vermicularis causes the common pinworm infection, which spreads when eggs are swallowed and often causes nighttime anal itching.

Enterobius Vermicularis

A small intestinal worm commonly called the pinworm or threadworm. Adult females lay eggs around the anus, usually at night, causing itching and allowing infection to spread through contaminated hands or surfaces.

Alternate Names:
Pinworm; Threadworm; Enterobius

Enterocele

A pelvic organ prolapse in which a pouch of abdominal lining and sometimes small intestine bulges into the space between the vagina and rectum. It may cause pelvic pressure, a vaginal bulge, back or rectal discomfort, or no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Small Bowel Prolapse; Douglas Pouch Hernia

Enterochromaffin Cells

Specialized enteroendocrine cells located throughout the mucosal epithelium of the gastrointestinal tract that synthesize, store, and release serotonin (5-hydroxytryptamine) and substance P to modulate gastrointestinal motility, secretion, and visceral pain perception.

Alternate Names:
EC Cells; Kultschitzky Cells

Enterochromaffin-Like Cells

Specialized neuroendocrine cells situated within the oxyntic mucosa of the gastric fundus and body that synthesize and secrete histamine in response to gastrin and acetylcholine stimulation, directly stimulating parietal cell H+/K+-ATPase proton pumps.

Alternate Names:
ECL Cells

Enteroclysis

An imaging test in which contrast material is delivered through a tube into the small intestine to look for inflammation, narrowing, tumors, or blockage. CT or MRI enterography is now more commonly used in many settings.

Enterococcaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Enterococcus species. These bacteria may normally live in the intestine but can cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or heart-valve infections when they enter protected body sites.

Enterococcal Infection

An infection caused by Enterococcus bacteria, which normally live in the intestine but can cause urinary-tract, wound, abdominal, bloodstream, or heart-valve infections. Enterococcal infections are more common after hospitalization, surgery, antibiotic exposure, or use of medical devices. Some strains resist multiple antibiotics, so culture and susceptibility testing guide treatment.

Alternate Names:
Enterococcosis

Enterococcus

A group of bacteria normally found in the intestine that can cause urinary, wound, abdominal, bloodstream, or heart-valve infection. Some strains resist several antibiotics and require laboratory susceptibility testing.

Enterococcus Durans

A bacterium that may live in the bowel but can rarely cause infection in seriously ill or immunocompromised people. It may affect blood, urine, wounds, or other sites, and testing guides antibiotic treatment.

Enterococcus Faecalis

A common intestinal bacterium that can cause urinary, wound, abdominal, bloodstream, or heart-valve infection. Disease is more likely after surgery, hospitalization, medical-device use, or when immunity is weakened.

Enterococcus Faecium

An Enterococcus species that can cause healthcare-associated urinary, wound, abdominal, bloodstream, or heart-valve infection. Some strains resist vancomycin and other antibiotics, making laboratory testing essential.

Enterocolitis

Inflammation of the small intestine and colon caused by infection, immune disease, reduced blood flow, toxins, or other injury. It may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, fever, vomiting, bleeding, dehydration, or severe illness.

Enterocyte

A cell lining the small intestine that digests and absorbs nutrients, water, and electrolytes. It also helps form the intestinal barrier and participates in immune defense.

Enterocytozoon

A group of tiny spore-forming parasites that can cause persistent diarrhea and intestinal disease, especially in people with weakened immunity. Some species can also affect other organs.

Enteroendocrine Cell

A specialized cell in the intestinal lining that senses food and releases hormones regulating digestion, appetite, gallbladder and pancreatic activity, and blood-glucose control.

Enterohepatic Circulation

Recycling of a substance from the liver into bile and the intestine, then back to the liver through the bloodstream. This can prolong the effects of some medicines and natural body chemicals.

Enteromonas Hominis

A usually harmless microorganism that may live in the intestine and appear in stool samples. It generally does not cause disease; significance depends on symptoms and other test results.

Enteropathic

Relating to intestinal disease or its effects elsewhere in the body. For example, enteropathic arthritis is joint inflammation associated with inflammatory bowel disease; intestinal disease can also be associated with skin or eye inflammation and poor nutrient absorption.

Enteropathic Arthritis

Inflammatory joint disease associated with inflammatory bowel disease such as Crohn disease or ulcerative colitis. It may affect the spine, joints between the spine and pelvis, or joints of the arms and legs.

Alternate Names:
Enteropathic Arthropathy; Enteropathic Arthropathies

Enteropathic Arthropathy

Alternate name; see *Enteropathic Arthritis*.

Enteropathy

Any disease or disorder affecting the intestine. Causes include infection, inflammation, gluten sensitivity, poor blood flow, toxins, medicines, inherited conditions, or impaired absorption.

Enteropathy-Associated T-Cell Lymphoma

A rare, fast-growing cancer of immune cells in the intestine. It can be linked to long-standing celiac disease and may cause severe abdominal pain, weight loss, poor nutrient absorption, blockage, or a hole in the bowel.

Alternate Names:
EATL; Enteropathy-Type Intestinal T-Cell Lymphoma

Enteroscopy

Examination of the small intestine with a camera-equipped instrument. It can identify disease, obtain tissue samples, treat bleeding, or remove selected growths beyond the reach of routine upper endoscopy.

Enterospasm

An involuntary tightening or contraction of the intestine that may cause cramping, abdominal pain, bloating, or altered movement of intestinal contents.

Enterostomy

A surgically created opening that brings part of the intestine to the abdominal surface so stool or intestinal contents can leave the body or a feeding

solution can enter.

Enterostomy Procedure

Surgery that creates an opening from the intestine to the abdominal wall, such as an ileostomy or colostomy. It may divert stool or support feeding; bleeding, infection, blockage, and skin problems can occur.

Enterotoxin

A toxin made by some microorganisms that acts on the intestinal lining and can cause vomiting, cramps, watery diarrhea, dehydration, or other intestinal illness.

Enterovesical Fistula

An abnormal connection between the intestine and urinary bladder. It can cause repeated urinary infections, air or stool in the urine, abdominal pain, or urine leaking into the intestine and may result from inflammation, cancer, or surgery.

Enterovirulent E. Coli

A group of Escherichia coli strains that cause intestinal disease by making toxins, attaching to the bowel, or invading it. Illness may include watery or bloody diarrhea, cramps, vomiting, or dehydration.

Enterovirus

A group of viruses spread mainly by respiratory secretions or contact with infected stool. Many infections are mild or cause no symptoms, but some cause hand-foot-and-mouth disease, rash, meningitis, heart inflammation, or severe illness in newborns.

Enterovirus D68

A virus that usually causes a respiratory illness but can rarely cause severe pneumonia or sudden weakness of the limbs, especially in children. It spreads mainly through respiratory secretions and contaminated surfaces.

Enterovirus Infection

Alternate name; see *Enterovirus*.

Enthesis

The place where a tendon, ligament, or joint capsule attaches to bone. Repeated stress or inflammation there can cause localized pain and stiffness and occurs in several inflammatory joint diseases.

Enthesitis

Inflammation where a tendon, ligament, or joint capsule attaches to bone. It can cause localized pain, tenderness, and stiffness and is common in spondyloarthritis, including psoriatic and inflammatory-bowel-disease-related arthritis.

Enthesitis And Enthesopathy

Enthesitis is inflammation where a tendon, ligament, or fascia attaches to bone. Enthesopathy includes inflammation, wear, injury, or other disease at that site and may cause localized pain and stiffness.

Alternate Names:
Enthesopathy; Insertion Tendinopathy

Enthesitis-Related Arthritis

A type of arthritis that begins in childhood and causes inflammation where tendons or ligaments attach to bone. It often affects the legs, feet, or lower back and may also cause swelling in joints or pain where the heel tendon attaches.

Alternate Names:
ERA; Juvenile Spondyloarthritis

Entorhinal Cortex

A region of the brain that links the hippocampus with other memory and navigation areas. It helps process spatial information and new memories and is affected early in many cases of Alzheimer disease.

ENT Physician

An otolaryngologist, a physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of the ear, nose, throat, and related head and neck structures.

Entrance Wound

The wound where a projectile enters the body. Its appearance may help estimate the direction and distance of the shot, but findings vary with the

weapon, clothing, body site, and circumstances and require forensic examination.

Entropion

Inward turning of an eyelid, usually the lower lid, so the eyelashes rub against the eye. It can cause irritation, tearing, pain, corneal scratches, infection, and reduced vision.

Enucleation

Surgical removal of an organ or a well-defined growth in one piece. In eye surgery, it means removing the eyeball while leaving most surrounding tissues in place; a growth may also be enucleated when it can be separated from nearby tissue.

Alternate Names:
Ocular Enucleation; Eye Enucleation; Surgical Enucleation

Enucleation Procedure

Alternate name; see *Enucleation*.

Enuresis

Repeated involuntary urination, usually during sleep in a child expected to remain dry. It may be primary or begin again after dryness; constipation, infection, diabetes, sleep problems, stress, or urinary disorders may contribute.

Environment

The physical, chemical, biological, and social surroundings in which a person lives or works. Environmental factors such as air, water, housing, noise, climate, and pollutants can influence health.

Environmental Exposure

Contact with a chemical, pollutant, organism, physical hazard, or other factor in the surroundings. Health effects depend on the substance, dose, route, duration, timing, and individual susceptibility.

Environmental Health

The field concerned with how surroundings affect human health. It includes air and water quality, food safety, housing, workplace hazards, climate, radiation, pollution, and prevention of harmful exposures.

Environmental Illness

Illness caused or worsened by an environmental exposure. Evaluation considers the timing, dose, setting, symptoms, other possible causes, and whether symptoms improve when exposure stops.

Enzyme

A protein, or occasionally an RNA molecule, that speeds a specific chemical reaction without being used up. Enzymes are essential for digestion, energy production, DNA processes, and many other cell functions.

Enzyme Activity

The rate at which an enzyme carries out a chemical reaction under specified conditions. It is affected by temperature, acidity, inhibitors, helper molecules, substrate amount, and enzyme concentration.

Enzyme Deficiency

Reduced or absent activity of an enzyme, usually inherited or sometimes acquired. It can cause buildup of substances, lack of needed products, and characteristic metabolic or cellular disease.

Enzyme Induction

Increased production or activity of an enzyme, often after exposure to a medicine or chemical. If liver drug-metabolizing enzymes are induced, some medicines may be broken down faster and become less effective.

Enzyme Inhibition

Reduced activity of an enzyme, sometimes caused by a medicine or chemical. If a drug-metabolizing enzyme is inhibited, another medicine may accumulate and cause stronger effects or toxicity.

Enzyme Kinetics

The study of how quickly enzyme reactions occur and how their rate changes with substrate amount, temperature, acidity, inhibitors, helper molecules,

and enzyme concentration.

Enzyme-Linked Immunosorbent Assay

A laboratory test that uses antibodies and an enzyme-generated color signal to detect or measure a target such as an antibody, antigen, hormone, or infection marker.

Enzyme Markers

Enzymes measured in blood or another body fluid to help assess tissue injury or organ function. Abnormal levels can suggest liver, bile-duct, muscle, heart, bone, or pancreatic disease but are not a diagnosis by themselves.

Enzyme Precursors

Inactive or weakly active proteins that become working enzymes after being cut or chemically changed. This allows the body to activate digestive and other enzymes at the correct place and time.

Enzyme Therapy

Treatment that replaces, supplements, blocks, or uses an enzyme to correct a deficiency or alter a disease process. The purpose, dose, benefits, and risks depend on the specific enzyme and condition.

Eosin

An acidic red dye used in histology, commonly with hematoxylin in H&E staining. It colors many cytoplasmic and extracellular proteins pink to red, helping show tissue structure.

Eosinophil

A specialized type of white blood cell that forms part of the immune system. Eosinophils play key roles in defending the body against parasitic infections (such as worms) and participate in allergic reactions and asthma. Elevated levels in the bloodstream often indicate an allergic response, asthma flare-up, medication reaction, or parasitic disease.

Alternate Names:
Eosinophils; Eosinophilic Granulocyte

Eosinophilia

An abnormally high number of eosinophils in the blood, commonly caused by allergy, parasites, medicines, autoimmune disease, or some blood disorders. Severe or persistent elevation can injure the heart, lungs, skin, nerves, or other organs.

Eosinophilia-Myalgia Syndrome

A potentially severe illness characterized by intense muscle pain and increased eosinophils, historically associated with contaminated L-tryptophan supplements. It may also cause rash, swelling, nerve symptoms, breathing problems, or internal-organ injury.

Eosinophilic Asthma

Asthma in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, contribute to airway inflammation. It may cause recurring wheezing, cough, chest tightness, or breathlessness and can be difficult to control in some people.

Eosinophilic Bronchitis

A cause of long-lasting cough in which eosinophils inflame the airways without the variable narrowing typical of asthma. The cough may resemble asthma or reflux.

Eosinophilic Esophagitis

A chronic immune-related disease in which eosinophils inflame the esophagus. It may cause difficulty swallowing, food becoming stuck, chest or upper-abdominal pain, reflux-like symptoms, and narrowing of the esophagus.

Eosinophilic Esophagitis Pathology

Esophageal mucosal disease with increased intraepithelial eosinophils, basal-zone hyperplasia, spongiosis, and sometimes lamina-propria fibrosis. Histologic findings are interpreted with symptoms and endoscopic features.

Eosinophilic Enteritis

A rare inflammatory disorder in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, build up in the small intestine. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea,

vomiting, diarrhea, bleeding, or poor nutrient absorption. Diagnosis uses tissue samples and checks for other causes of eosinophils.

Eosinophilic Fasciitis

A rare inflammatory disease causing painful swelling and hardening of the deeper skin and tissue around muscles, usually in the arms or legs. Blood eosinophils may be high, and joint stiffness or limited movement can develop.

Alternate Names:
Shulman Syndrome; Diffuse Fasciitis with Eosinophilia

Eosinophilic Gastroenteritis

A rare immune-related disease in which eosinophils inflame the stomach or intestines. Symptoms may include abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, bleeding, poor absorption, or weight loss.

Eosinophilic Gastritis

Inflammation of the stomach lining with an unusually large number of eosinophils, a type of white blood cell. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, or feeling full early. Diagnosis uses symptoms and stomach tissue samples while checking for other causes of eosinophils.

Eosinophilic Gastrointestinal Disorders

Conditions in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, build up in one or more parts of the digestive tract and cause inflammation. Symptoms may include pain, vomiting, swallowing difficulty, diarrhea, or poor growth; diagnosis usually requires endoscopy and biopsy.

Eosinophilic Granuloma

A localized form of Langerhans-cell disease in which abnormal immune cells collect, often in bone or skin. Bone lesions can cause pain, swelling, or fractures and may require imaging and tissue examination.

Eosinophilic Granuloma (Pulmonary Histiocytosis X)

Historical or imprecise label; see *Pulmonary Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis*.

Eosinophilic Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis

A rare disease in which inflamed blood vessels occur with asthma and high levels of eosinophils, a type of white blood cell. It can damage the lungs, skin, nerves, heart, kidneys, or digestive organs.

Alternate Names:
Allergic Granulomatosis Allergic Granulomatosis and Angiitis

Eosinophilic Pneumonia

A group of lung diseases in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, build up in the lungs. It may cause cough, fever, and shortness of breath. Causes include medicines, parasites, and immune disease; sometimes no cause is found.

Eosinophilic Pneumonia Pathology

Lung inflammation rich in eosinophils involving alveolar spaces, interstitium, or both. Additional findings may include organizing pneumonia, edema, and eosinophilic infiltrates around vessels or airways.

Eosinophils

Plural form; see *Eosinophil*.

Ependyma

A specialized layer of cells lining the brain's fluid-filled ventricles and the spinal cord's central canal. It helps separate nervous tissue from cerebrospinal fluid and supports movement of that fluid.

Ependymal Cell

A supporting cell lining the brain ventricles and spinal cord central canal. It helps maintain the cerebrospinal-fluid boundary and, in some areas, helps move or produce the fluid.

Ependymal Tumor

Alternate name; see *Ependymoma*.

Ependymoblastoma

A rare, aggressive brain tumor of childhood made from very immature cells. It may cause headache, vomiting, seizures, or changes in movement or devel-

opment; tissue and genetic testing guide treatment and outlook.

Ependymoma

A tumor arising from cells lining the brain ventricles or spinal canal. It may block fluid flow and cause headache, vomiting, seizures, balance problems, weakness, or hydrocephalus, especially in children.

Ephedrine

A stimulant that activates the sympathetic nervous system and can widen airways and raise blood pressure and heart rate. It has limited medical uses and may cause palpitations, insomnia, anxiety, high blood pressure, or misuse.

Ephedrinum

Another name for ephedrine, a stimulant that can increase heart rate, blood pressure, alertness, and airway diameter. Excessive use may cause dangerous heart-rhythm, blood-pressure, or nervous-system effects.

Ephelides

Small, flat freckles caused by increased pigment production, often inherited. They become darker with sunlight and usually fade when exposure decreases; sun protection helps prevent further pigment change and skin damage.

Ephrins

Proteins on the surface of cells that help guide cell position, nerve growth, blood-vessel development, and tissue organization. Abnormal ephrin signaling can contribute to some diseases and cancers.

Epiblast

A layer of cells in the early embryo that develops into the three main cell layers of the body and ultimately forms most tissues and organs.

Epicanthal Folds

Skin folds of the upper eyelid that partly cover the inner corner of the eye. They are normal in many people but can also occur with some chromosome or developmental conditions.

Alternate Names:
Epicanthus

Epicardium

The thin outer layer of the heart wall and the inner layer of its surrounding protective sac. It contains connective tissue, fat, blood vessels, and nerves and helps reduce friction as the heart beats.

Epichlorohydrin

An industrial chemical used to make resins and other materials. Exposure can irritate or burn the skin, eyes, and airways; swallowing or substantial exposure can cause serious poisoning and requires urgent medical advice.

Epicondyle

A bony projection beside a rounded joint surface where muscles and ligaments attach. Repeated strain or injury around an elbow epicondyle can cause localized pain and weakness.

Epicondylitis

Pain and tenderness where a tendon attaches near an epicondyle, usually from repeated strain rather than infection. At the elbow it can weaken gripping and wrist movement and is commonly called tennis or golfer's elbow.

Epicondylitis (Tennis Elbow)

Overuse-related pain at the outer elbow, usually involving tendons that attach forearm muscles to the lateral epicondyle. Despite the name, it is generally tendinopathy rather than acute inflammation and may cause pain with gripping or wrist extension.

Epidemic

An increase in disease cases above the number normally expected in a population, place, or period. An epidemic may result from infection, environmental exposure, behavior, or another shared cause.

Epidemic Cerebrospinal Meningitis

Historical name; see *Meningococcal Meningitis*.

Epidemic Cholera

Alternate name; see *Cholera*.

Epidemic Keratoconjunctivitis

A very contagious viral infection of the eye. It can cause red eyes, pain, watering, swollen eyelids, light sensitivity, blurred vision, and swollen glands near the ear; symptoms may last for weeks.

Alternate Names:
EKC; Adenoviral Keratoconjunctivitis; Shipyard Eye

Epidemiological Study

A study of health and disease in groups of people. It may measure how often a condition occurs, compare possible causes or exposures, or examine outcomes over time to help guide prevention and healthcare planning.

Alternate Names:
Epidemiologic Study

Epidemiologic Method

A structured way to measure how often a health problem occurs and to study whether exposures, behaviors, or other factors are associated with it in a population. Results guide prevention and policy.

Epidemiologic Studies

Research that examines the distribution, causes, risk factors, prevention, or outcomes of health events in populations.

Epidemiologist

A scientist or public-health professional who studies the distribution, causes, risk factors, and prevention of health conditions in populations.

Epidemiology

The study of how often diseases and other health events occur, who is affected, and which factors influence them. It uses population data to identify causes, guide prevention, investigate outbreaks, and evaluate healthcare.

Epidermal

Relating to the epidermis, the outermost layer of skin. An epidermal problem affects this protective surface layer rather than the deeper skin tissues.

Epidermal Acanthosis

Thickening of the epidermis caused by increased growth of its cells, seen in conditions such as psoriasis, chronic rubbing, and some inflammatory or genetic skin disorders.

Epidermal Cells

Cells forming the outer layer of skin, chiefly keratinocytes, which create a protective barrier; melanocytes, immune cells, and touch-associated cells are also present.

Epidermal Growth Factor

A signaling protein that binds the epidermal-growth-factor receptor and promotes cell growth, survival, and tissue repair; abnormal signaling can contribute to cancer.

Epidermal Inclusion Cyst

A common, usually harmless lump beneath the skin filled with keratin, a protein found in skin. It often has a small central opening and may become swollen, painful, infected, or recur if its wall remains.

Epidermal Layers

The epidermis has several layers of cells that make and protect the skin. From deepest to most superficial they are basal, spinous, granular, clear, and horny layers; the clear layer is mainly in the palms and soles.

Epidermal Nevus

A usually benign, often present-from-birth or childhood skin lesion caused by an overgrowth of epidermal cells. It commonly appears as a localized, linear, or warty thickened patch and may occur with other developmental abnormalities.

Epidermal Nevus Syndrome

A group of mosaic developmental disorders in which extensive or systematized epidermal nevi occur with abnormalities of the brain, eyes, skeleton, limbs, or other organs. Evaluation is guided by the distribution of the nevi and associated neurologic, ocular, or musculoskeletal findings.

Epidermis

The outer layer of skin that forms a protective barrier against injury, germs, and water loss. It contains cells that make keratin and pigment, as well as immune and touch-sensing cells, and it is replaced continuously.

Epidermodysplasia Verruciformis

A rare inherited or acquired disorder of cutaneous immunity in which susceptibility to specific beta-human papillomaviruses causes persistent flat wart-like or pityriasis-versicolor-like lesions. Sun-exposed lesions can develop actinic keratosis and cutaneous squamous-cell carcinoma, so lifelong skin surveillance and sun protection are important.

Epidermoid Cyst

A benign, slow-growing, intradermal or subcutaneous cystic lesion lined by a true, orderly stratified squamous epithelium with a distinct granular cell layer, containing laminated, cheesy, foul-smelling keratinaceous debris. Commonly misnamed "sebaceous cyst," it does not originate from sebaceous glands but arises from follicular infundibular epithelium, traumatic epidermal inclusion, or embryonic sequestration during closure of ectodermal lines. Classically presents as a firm, mobile, non-tender, dome-shaped cutaneous nodule, frequently exhibiting a central punctum (the plugged follicular orifice), most commonly situated on the face, neck, scalp, and upper trunk. Rupture of the cyst wall releases keratin into the surrounding dermis, provoking a vigorous, acutely painful foreign-body inflammatory reaction that mimics secondary bacterial infection. Definitive curative management requires complete surgical excision of the intact cyst wall (capsule); incomplete excision of the lining frequently leads to local recurrence.

Alternate Names:
Epidermoid Cysts; Epidermal Inclusion Cyst; Infundibular Cyst

Epidermoid Cysts

Plural form; see *Epidermoid Cyst*.

Epidermolysis Bullosa

A group of rare disorders causing fragile skin that blisters or tears after minor friction or trauma. Most forms result from inherited defects in proteins that anchor skin layers; epidermolysis bullosa acquisita is an acquired autoimmune form. Blisters may affect mucous membranes and heal with or without scarring, depending on the subtype.

Alternate Names:
Bullosa Hereditaria; Hereditary Epidermolysis Bullosa

Epidermolysis Bullosa Acquisita

An uncommon autoimmune blistering disease in which antibodies target type VII collagen, a protein anchoring the epidermis to the dermis. Tense blisters and erosions develop after minor trauma, often heal with scarring or milia, and may affect mucous membranes.

Epidermolytic Ichthyosis

An inherited keratinization disorder, usually caused by variants in KRT1 or KRT10, in which newborns may have widespread redness and superficial blistering that later evolves into thick, scaling skin and sometimes palmoplantar keratoderma.

Alternate Names:
Epidermolytic Hyperkeratosis; Bullous Congenital Ichthyosiform Erythroderma

Epidermophyton

A group of fungi that grow in keratin, a tough protein in skin, hair, and nails. They can cause ringworm infections, including itchy, scaly skin disease and fungal infection of the nails, but do not usually infect living hair shafts.

Epidermophyton Floccosum

A dermatophyte fungus that commonly causes tinea of the body, groin, and feet and can infect nails.

Epididymal Cyst

A usually benign, fluid-filled cyst arising in the epididymis. It may be painless; larger cysts can cause discomfort or other complications.

Epididymal Neoplasm

A benign or malignant growth arising in the epididymis; most palpable epididymal masses are benign, though persistent or enlarging lesions can have varied causes.

Epididymides

The paired coiled ducts on the posterior surface of the testes where sperm mature and are stored before entering the vasa deferentia.

Alternate Names:
Epididymal Ducts

Epididymis

A tightly coiled tube along the back of each testicle where sperm mature, gain the ability to move, and are stored before passing into the vas deferens. It has a head, body, and tail.

Epididymitis

Inflammation of the epididymis, usually caused by infection. It often causes gradually developing, one-sided scrotal pain and swelling. Causes include sexually transmitted infections, urinary bacteria, urinary obstruction, and less often injury or medicines. Sudden severe pain can occur with testicular torsion.

Epididymitis And Orchitis

Alternate name for epididymo-orchitis, inflammation of the epididymis and testicle.

Epididymo-Orchitis

Inflammation of the epididymis and testicle, usually caused by an infection. It can cause one-sided scrotal pain, swelling, redness, painful urination, and fever. The cause may be a sexually transmitted infection or bacteria from the urinary tract, depending on the person and situation. Sudden severe pain can also occur with testicular torsion; treatment depends on the cause.

Alternate Names:
Epididymo-orchitis; Testicular and Epididymal Inflammation; Orchiepididymitis

Epidural

Regional analgesia or anesthesia produced by injecting medicine into the epidural space outside the dura surrounding the spinal cord. A catheter often allows continuous or repeated dosing. Epidurals provide pain relief during labor, surgery, and postoperative recovery. Unlike spinal anesthesia, the medicine is delivered outside the cerebrospinal fluid.

Epidural Abscess

A pocket of pus between the tough outer covering of the brain or spinal cord and nearby bone. It can compress the brain, spinal cord, or nerves, causing fever, severe pain, weakness, numbness, or loss of bladder control and requires emergency treatment.

Epidural Analgesia

Pain relief produced by delivering numbing medicine, sometimes with an opioid, through a small catheter into the space around the spinal nerves. It may be used during labor or surgery while the person remains awake. Low blood pressure, itching, headache, infection, or incomplete relief can occur.

Epidural Analgesia For Labor

Pain relief during labor provided through a small catheter placed in the lower back. Numbing medicine, sometimes with an opioid, is given gradually to reduce pain while allowing the laboring person to remain awake and participate in birth. Temporary low blood pressure, itching, headache, or incomplete relief can occur.

Epidural Anesthesia

Regional anesthesia produced by injecting numbing medicine, sometimes with an opioid, into the space around the spinal nerves. It blocks pain from part of the body while the person stays awake; low blood

pressure, headache, infection, or nerve injury can rarely occur.

Alternate Names:
Epidural Anaesthesia

Epidural Blood Patch

A procedure that injects a small amount of the person's own blood into the space around the spinal nerves to seal a leak after spinal anesthesia or an accidental puncture. It usually treats a severe positional headache; back pain, infection, or another puncture can occur.

Epidural Hematoma

A serious condition in which blood accumulates between the skull bone and the tough outer membrane covering the brain (the dura mater). It usually results from a traumatic blow to the head that fractures the skull and tears an underlying artery. As bleeding rapidly increases pressure inside the skull, it can compress brain tissue. A classic feature is a brief period of unconsciousness followed by a temporary lucid interval of alertness, before rapid deterioration with severe headache, vomiting, confusion, and loss of consciousness.

Alternate Names:
Extradural Hematoma; EDH

Epidural Neoplasm

A tumor in the space outside the dura surrounding the spinal cord or brain; spinal epidural tumors can compress nerves or the spinal cord and cause pain, weakness, or sensory loss.

Epidural Space

The space between the tough outer covering of the spinal canal and the canal wall. Medicines injected there can reduce pain during childbirth, surgery, or some pain treatments.

Epidural Steroid Injection

An injection of corticosteroid into the space around spinal nerves, usually guided by X-ray. It may reduce pain from an irritated or compressed nerve, such as with a herniated disc, but relief varies and may be temporary. Risks include bleeding, infection, headache, and a temporary rise in blood sugar.

Alternate Names:
ESI; Epidural Corticosteroid Injection

Epigastric

Relating to the upper middle area of the abdomen between the ribs. Pain there may arise from the stomach, esophagus, pancreas, gallbladder, intestine, or other organs.

Epigastric Artery

An artery supplying the front abdominal wall. The superior and inferior epigastric arteries provide blood to abdominal muscles and skin and are important landmarks during some procedures.

Epigastric Pain

Pain or discomfort in the upper middle abdomen, below the ribs and above the navel. Causes include indigestion, ulcer, reflux, gallbladder disease, pancreatitis, and other conditions; pain may be severe or persistent.

Epigastric Region

The upper middle section of the abdomen between the rib margins and above the navel. It overlies parts of the stomach, duodenum, pancreas, and liver; pain there can have several digestive or vascular causes.

Epigastrium

The upper middle part of the abdomen, below the breastbone and between the ribs. It overlies parts of the stomach, liver, pancreas, and small intestine; pain there has many possible causes.

Epigenetics

Changes in how genes are switched on or off without changing the DNA sequence itself. Chemical tags and DNA-packaging changes can be influenced by development, environment, and illness and may sometimes be reversible.

Epigenome

The collection of chemical tags and DNA-packaging features that help control which genes are active in

a cell without changing the DNA sequence.

Epigenomics

The study of chemical and structural changes that control which genes are active across the genome without changing the DNA sequence. These changes can influence development, disease, and treatment response.

Epiglottic Vallecula

A shallow mucosal depression situated in the glossoepiglottic space between the base of the tongue and the anterior surface of the epiglottis, bounded by median and lateral glossoepiglottic folds, serving as the anatomical seat for the tip of a curved Macintosh laryngoscope blade during endotracheal intubation.

Alternate Names:
Vallecula Epiglottica; Vallecular Fossa

Epiglottis

A leaf-shaped flap of flexible tissue at the base of the tongue that helps direct food and liquid into the esophagus during swallowing and away from the airway. Swelling can rapidly obstruct breathing.

Epiglottitis

Rapid swelling of the epiglottis, the flap at the entrance to the windpipe that helps keep food and liquid out during swallowing. It is usually caused by bacteria. The swelling can narrow or block the breathing passage and cause fever, severe sore throat, drooling, trouble swallowing, or noisy breathing.

Alternate Names:
Supraglottitis

Epilepsia Partialis Continua

Repeated or nearly continuous twitching in one part of the body, often an arm, leg, or side of the face. Awareness may remain normal, and the condition can last for hours or longer.

Alternate Names:
EPC; Kojewnikoff Syndrome

Epilepsy

A chronic neurological disorder characterized by recurrent, unprovoked seizures. A seizure occurs when sudden, abnormal surges of electrical activity disrupt normal communication between brain cells. The nature of seizures varies widely, from brief staring spells or muscle twitches to convulsions with loss of consciousness. It can stem from brain injuries, strokes, genetic factors, or infections, though in many cases no specific cause is found.

Alternate Names:
Seizure Disorder

Epilepsy and Seizures

Epilepsy is a brain disorder involving an enduring tendency to have unprovoked seizures. A seizure is a discrete episode of abnormal brain electrical activity and may also result from a temporary provoking cause; one seizure alone does not necessarily mean a person has epilepsy.

Epilepsy Surgery

Surgery or a procedure used for selected people whose seizures continue despite appropriate medicines and arise from an area that can be safely treated. Detailed testing identifies the seizure source and estimates benefits and risks.

Epileptic Spasms

Brief seizures, most common in infancy, in which the head, body, arms, or legs suddenly bend or stiffen. They often occur in clusters and may be associated with developmental impairment, depending on the underlying cause and epilepsy syndrome.

Epileptiform

Resembling a seizure or the electrical pattern associated with seizure activity. It may describe movements or an EEG finding but does not by itself prove that a person has epilepsy.

Epimysium

A substantial sheath of dense irregular collagenous connective tissue that completely envelops the entire exterior surface of a skeletal muscle, continuous with tendons, muscular fascial planes, and the periosteum

of bone.

Epinephrin

Alternate spelling; see *Epinephrine*.

Epinephrine

A hormone and neurotransmitter released during stress that increases heart activity, opens the airways, and narrows many blood vessels. As a medicine, it treats anaphylaxis and selected cardiac or breathing emergencies.

Alternate Names:
Adrenaline

Epineurium

The thick, outermost fibrous connective tissue sheath that encloses an entire peripheral nerve, surrounding multiple nerve fascicles, longitudinal blood vessels (vasa nervorum), and adipose tissue to provide tensile mechanical protection.

Epiphora

Excessive tearing caused by blocked tear drainage or irritation that triggers extra tears. Causes include dry eye, allergy, infection, eyelid position problems, and blockage of the tear duct.

Epiphyseal Plate

The growth plate, a layer of cartilage near the end of a growing bone that allows the bone to lengthen. It gradually closes after puberty; injury can cause pain, deformity, or unequal growth.

Alternate Names:
Growth Plate; Physis

Epiphyseal Plate Disorders

Conditions affecting a growing bone's growth plate, including fractures, inflammation, infection, abnormal blood supply, premature closure, and disorders in which an epiphysis shifts or separates. They may cause pain, swelling, limping, deformity, or unequal limb growth.

Epiphysis

The expanded end of a long bone, usually covered by smooth cartilage where it forms a joint. It contains mostly spongy bone and helps determine the shape and movement of the joint.

Epiphysitis

Inflammation or injury involving a growth plate or the area near the end of a growing bone. It may cause localized pain, swelling, or altered growth, and the cause depends on age and the affected bone.

Epiploic Foramen

The narrow anatomical communication aperture connecting the greater peritoneal sac with the lesser sac (omental bursa), bounded anteriorly by the hepatoduodenal ligament (containing the portal triad), posteriorly by the inferior vena cava, superiorly by the caudate lobe of the liver, and inferiorly by the first part of the duodenum.

Alternate Names:
Foramen of Winslow

Epipodophyllotoxin

A group of cancer medicines derived from a plant compound that damage DNA by blocking an enzyme needed for cell division. They treat selected cancers but may cause low blood counts, nausea, hair loss, infection, or rarely a later blood cancer.

Epiretinal Membrane

A thin layer of cells and connective tissue that forms on the inner surface of the retina, usually over the macula. It may contract, wrinkle the retina, and distort central vision.

Alternate Names:
Macular Pucker

Epirubicin

An anthracycline cancer medicine that damages DNA and blocks cell division. Important risks include low blood counts, infection, nausea, hair loss, tissue injury after leakage, and dose-related heart damage.

Epirubicin Hydrochloride

Drug salt; see *Epirubicin*.

Episcleritis

Usually short-lived inflammation of the thin tissue over the white of the eye, causing a localized red patch and mild tenderness or discomfort. Severe pain, light sensitivity, or vision loss suggests deeper eye disease.

Episiotomy

A cut made in the tissue between the vagina and anus during vaginal birth to enlarge the opening. Routine use is not recommended; selected use may help urgent or assisted delivery but can cause pain, bleeding, infection, or deeper tearing.

Episiotomy Repair

Closing an episiotomy or related tear with stitches after birth. The area is examined to identify deeper injury, and care includes pain relief, hygiene, monitoring for infection, and follow-up of healing and pelvic-floor function.

Episodic Ataxia

An inherited condition causing repeated attacks of poor coordination and balance. Episodes may last seconds to hours and can include dizziness, slurred speech, muscle tightening, or abnormal eye movements, with improvement between attacks.

Epispadias

A birth defect in which the urethral opening is on the upper surface of the penis or in an unusual position in a female. It may affect urine control and is sometimes associated with bladder-exstrophy conditions.

Epistasis

A genetic interaction in which one gene changes or masks the effect of another gene. This can alter inherited traits and complicate how a disease risk or laboratory finding is predicted from genetic testing.

Epistaxis

Medical term; see *Nosebleeds*.

Epithalamic

Relating to the epithalamus, a small region near the center of the brain that includes the pineal gland and structures involved in sleep timing, hormonal rhythms, and responses to reward or stress.

Epithalamus

A dorsal posterior division of the diencephalon comprising the pineal gland (epiphysis cerebri), the habenular nuclei, the stria medullaris thalami, and the posterior commissure, involved in circadian melatonin rhythmicity and limbic-midbrain connections.

Epithelial

Relating to cells that cover the skin, line body passages and organs, or form glands. These cells protect surfaces and may absorb substances, release fluids, or help detect changes.

Epithelial Cells

Cells that cover the skin, line body passages and organs, and form many glands. They create a protective barrier and may absorb substances, release fluids, move material, or sense changes in their surroundings.

Alternate Names:
Epithelial Tissue Cells

Epithelial Cyst

A usually benign, enclosed sac lined by surface-type cells and filled with fluid, mucus, or a skin protein called keratin. It may enlarge, become painful, or become infected and sometimes requires removal.

Epithelial Tissue

Tissue made of closely packed cells that covers the skin, lines internal spaces and tubes, and forms glands. It provides protection and may absorb, secrete, transport, or exchange substances.

Epithelioid Cell

A rounded cell that resembles a surface-lining cell. The term often describes an activated immune cell in a granuloma, but it can also describe the appearance of some tumors.

Epithelioid Histiocyte

An activated macrophage that has undergone structural transformation under the influence of interferon-gamma in chronic granulomatous inflammation, acquiring abundant pale eosinophilic cytoplasm, elongated slipper-shaped nuclei, and indistinct cell borders resembling epithelial cells.

Epithelioid Sarcoma

A rare cancer of connective or soft tissue, often beginning in the skin or deeper tissues of the hands, forearms, feet, or lower limbs. It may recur or spread and requires specialist treatment.

Epithelioid Trophoblastic Tumor

A rare pregnancy-related cancer arising from cells that normally help form the placenta. It may appear months or years after pregnancy, cause abnormal bleeding, and requires specialist cancer treatment.

Epithelioma

An older or broad term for a tumor arising from epithelial cells; the specific diagnosis should identify whether it is benign, precancerous, or malignant.

Epitheliopathy

Disease or damage of epithelial tissue, the cells that cover body surfaces and line organs. The term alone does not specify the affected tissue or the type of damage; these are identified separately, as in corneal epitheliopathy.

Epithelium

A layer or sheet of closely packed cells covering the skin, lining body spaces and tubes, or forming glands. It protects surfaces and may absorb substances, release fluids, transport material, or allow exchange.

Epitope

The small, specific part of an antigen that is recognized by an antibody or immune-cell receptor. Recognition can trigger an immune response; epitopes are important in infections, vaccines, allergies, and antibody-based treatments.

Epitope Mapping

The process of identifying an epitope, the small part of an antigen recognized by an antibody or specific immune-cell receptor. It helps researchers understand immune responses and develop vaccines, diagnostic tests, and antibody-based treatments.

Eplerenone

A medicine that blocks aldosterone, a hormone that promotes salt retention and heart remodeling. It treats high blood pressure and selected heart-failure patients; kidney function and blood potassium require monitoring.

Epley Maneuver

A sequence of head and body movements that returns displaced inner-ear particles to their usual position. It can relieve brief spinning triggered by head movement in posterior-canal positional vertigo.

Epoetin Alfa

A laboratory-made form of erythropoietin that stimulates the bone marrow to produce red blood cells. It treats selected anemias, but can raise blood pressure and the risk of blood clots if hemoglobin rises too high.

Epoetin Beta

A laboratory-made form of erythropoietin used for selected anemias, including some caused by chronic kidney disease. It may cause high blood pressure or blood clots.

Eponym

A medical name derived from a person's name or another proper name, such as the name of a disease, sign, procedure, or body structure. Eponyms may be replaced by descriptive terms to improve clarity.

Epoprostenol

A short-acting medicine that widens blood vessels in the lungs and reduces platelet clumping. Continuous intravenous infusion treats severe pulmonary arterial hypertension; interruption can cause rapid worsening.

EPO Test

Abbreviation; see *Erythropoietin Test*.

Epoxide Hydrolase

An enzyme that changes reactive chemicals called epoxides into less reactive substances. It helps process some medicines, toxins, and natural fats and can influence their effects and the risk of tissue injury.

Epoxy Compounds

Chemicals containing a reactive group used in adhesives, coatings, plastics, and other materials. Uncured components can irritate the skin and eyes, cause allergic skin inflammation, or irritate the airways; workplace exposure may cause asthma.

Epsom Salts

Magnesium sulfate crystals used in some baths and, occasionally, as a laxative. Drinking them can cause diarrhea or magnesium poisoning, especially in people with kidney disease, so medical advice is important.

Epstein-Barr Virus

A common virus spread mainly through saliva. It can cause infectious mononucleosis and remains dormant in the body; it is also linked to some lymphomas, other cancers, and immune disorders.

Epstein-Barr Virus Antibody Test

A blood test that measures antibodies produced against Epstein-Barr virus. The pattern of antibodies, symptoms, and timing can help distinguish recent infection from past infection, but results need clinical interpretation.

Epstein Pearls

Small, white, harmless cysts containing keratin that appear on a newborn's gums or roof of the mouth. They usually disappear within weeks without treatment and should not be squeezed.

Eptifibatide

An injectable antiplatelet medicine used during selected urgent coronary treatments. It prevents platelets from clumping by blocking a platelet-binding receptor, but can cause serious bleeding and requires blood-count and kidney monitoring.

Epulis

A localized growth arising from the gum or tissues around a tooth. Most are reactive and benign, but persistent, painful, bleeding, or enlarging growths need dental examination and sometimes biopsy.

Equilibrium Receptors

Sensory cells in the inner ear that detect head movement and position. Signals from them, the eyes, and muscles help the brain maintain balance and coordinate posture and eye movements.

Equilin

An estrogen hormone found mainly in pregnant mares and included in some mixtures of conjugated estrogens. Estrogen treatment can increase the risk of blood clots and other adverse effects and requires individualized medical advice.

Equine Morbillivirus

A historical name for Hendra virus, a henipavirus in the family *Paramyxoviridae*. It was identified during outbreaks of severe respiratory and neurologic disease in horses and can also infect people and other mammals.

Equinovarus Deformity

A deformity in which the foot points downward and turns inward. It may be present at birth or develop from muscle, nerve, joint, or bone problems, limiting walking and requiring cause-specific treatment.

Equipment Safety

Measures that reduce harm from medical devices by using the correct equipment, checking it before use, cleaning it properly, maintaining it, and training users. Faulty equipment should be removed from service.

Equivalence Trial

A clinical study designed to determine whether a new treatment and an established treatment have effects within a predefined clinically acceptable range of one another. The range must be set before results are analyzed.

Eradication

Complete removal of an infection or disease from a person or population. For an individual infection, eradication may require a full treatment course and a follow-up test to confirm that the organism is gone.

Erbb Receptors

A family of cell-surface proteins that receive growth signals and regulate cell division, survival, and specialization. Abnormal activity in some members can promote cancers and may guide targeted treatment.

Erbium

A chemical element used in specialized lasers and materials. Erbium lasers can precisely remove or remodel selected skin and dental tissue; treatment may cause pain, burns, pigment changes, or scarring.

Erb Palsy

A peripheral obstetric or traumatic traction injury to the upper trunk of the brachial plexus involving spinal nerve roots C5 and C6 (and sometimes C7), causing paralysis of the deltoid, supraspinatus, infraspinatus, and biceps brachii muscles, resulting in an adducted, internally rotated shoulder and extended, pronated forearm ('waiter's tip' posture).

Alternate Names:
Erb-Duchenne Palsy; Upper Trunk Brachial Plexus Palsy

Erb's Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of the shoulder and arm caused by injury to the upper nerves of the brachial plexus, often during difficult birth. The arm may hang inward with the elbow straight and palm facing backward.

ERCP

A procedure using a flexible camera and X-ray guidance to diagnose or treat blocked, narrowed, or leaking bile or pancreatic ducts. It can remove stones or place a stent, but may cause pancreatitis, bleeding, infection, or perforation.

Erdheim-Chester Disease

A rare clonal histiocytic neoplasm associated with mutations in the MAPK signalling pathway, including BRAF V600E. It can affect multiple organs; characteristic findings include symmetric sclerosis of the long bones and infiltrative changes around the aorta or kidneys.

Alternate Names:
ECD; Non-Langerhans Histiocytosis

Erectile Disorder

Alternate name; see *Erectile Dysfunction*.

Erectile Dysfunction

Ongoing difficulty getting or keeping an erection firm enough for sex. It can be linked to blood-flow problems, diabetes, nerve or hormone conditions, medicines, stress, or depression. It may also be an early sign of heart or blood-vessel disease.

Erection

Temporary enlargement and stiffening of the penis when blood fills erectile tissue and drainage through veins decreases. It can occur with sexual stimulation, during sleep, or spontaneously and normally subsides afterward.

Erector Spinae

A group of muscles running along both sides of the spine. They straighten and stabilize the back and help bend the spine sideways during standing, walking, and lifting.

Alternate Names:
Sacrospinalis Muscle; Spinalis and Longissimus Complex

Ergocalciferol

Vitamin D2, a form of vitamin D used to prevent or

treat deficiency. It helps the body absorb calcium and maintain bones, but excessive doses can cause high blood calcium, nausea, confusion, or kidney injury.

Ergolines

A family of compounds related to chemicals made by ergot fungi. Some affect serotonin, dopamine, or adrenaline receptors and are used or studied for migraine, hormone disorders, or neurologic conditions.

Ergometrine

A medicine that contracts the uterus and narrows some blood vessels. It may help control severe bleeding after childbirth, but can dangerously raise blood pressure and is unsuitable for some people with hypertension or heart disease.

Ergonomics

Designing work, tools, furniture, and environments to match the body's abilities and limits. Good ergonomics can reduce strain, awkward posture, repetitive-injury risk, fatigue, and errors.

Ergosterol

A fat-like substance that helps maintain fungal cell membranes. Many antifungal medicines damage fungi by binding ergosterol or blocking its production; human cells use cholesterol instead.

Ergot

The dark, sclerotial resting stage of the parasitic fungus *Claviceps purpurea*, which infects cereal grains, particularly rye. Ergot produces potent pharmacologically active indole alkaloids (including ergotamine, ergometrine/ergonovine, and dihydroergotamine) that act as complex partial agonists and antagonists at adrenergic (α_1), serotonergic (5-HT_1, 5-HT_2), and dopaminergic (D_2) receptors. Therapeutically harnessed for acute abortive migraine treatment (via vasoconstriction of dilated extracranial arteries and inhibition of trigeminal sensory nerve activation) and prevention of postpartum uterine hemorrhage (via sustained myometrial contraction). Ingestion of contaminated flour or overdose of ergot medications produces ergotism ("St. Anthony's fire"), characterized by intense peripheral vasoconstriction leading to acral ischemia, gangrene of extremities, burning pain, and neuroconvulsive symptoms (hallucinations, seizures).

Alternate Names:
Ergots; Claviceps purpurea; Ergot Alkaloids

Ergotamine

A medicine that narrows certain blood vessels and can stop some migraine attacks. It has many interactions and should not be overused because it can cause dangerous loss of blood flow to the limbs or organs.

Ergotism

Poisoning caused by ergot toxins or excessive ergot-derived medicines. Severe blood-vessel narrowing can cause burning pain, numbness, cold or discolored limbs, confusion, seizures, tissue death, or dangerous uterine contractions.

Ergots

Plural form; see *Ergot*.

Eribulin Mesylate

A cancer medicine that interferes with microtubules, structures needed for cell division. It is used for selected advanced breast cancers and liposarcomas; common risks include low blood counts, nerve damage, fatigue, and nausea.

Erlotinib Hydrochloride

A cancer medicine that blocks growth signals from the epidermal growth-factor receptor. It treats selected cancers with suitable molecular changes and may cause rash, diarrhea, liver injury, or lung inflammation.

Erosion

Loss of only the surface layer of skin or a moist lining, without the deeper tissue loss of an ulcer. Friction, inflammation, infection, injury, or chemicals may cause it and may produce pain or bleeding.

Erosion Lesion

A shallow area where the surface layer of skin or a moist lining has been lost. It may result from rubbing, inflammation, infection, injury, or chemicals and usually heals when the cause is removed.

Erosive Esophagitis

Inflammation of the swallowing tube with visible breaks in its lining, usually from repeated stomach-acid reflux. It can cause painful swallowing, heartburn, or bleeding and may lead to narrowing if untreated.

Erosive Gastritis

Inflammation of the stomach lining with shallow breaks in its surface. It may cause pain, vomiting, or bleeding. Medicines, alcohol, infection, or severe illness can contribute; when injury occurs with little inflammation, it is called erosive gastropathy.

Erosive Lichen Planus

A long-lasting immune-mediated inflammation that causes painful raw areas, burning, bleeding, or soreness in the mouth or genital tissues. Scarring and narrowing may develop, so examination and treatment can help protect function.

Alternate Names:
Vulvovaginal Gingival Syndrome; Erosive Vulvovaginal Lichen Planus

Erratic Results

Test results that change unexpectedly or do not agree with repeated measurements. Possible causes include sample problems, device error, normal biological variation, medicines, or a test that does not fit the clinical question.

Ertapenem

A once-daily antibiotic for selected serious infections caused by susceptible bacteria. It does not reliably treat Pseudomonas or enterococcal infections and can cause diarrhea, allergic reactions, seizures, or antibiotic-resistant organisms.

Erucic Acid

A naturally occurring monounsaturated fatty acid found in the seeds of certain plants, particularly unrefined rapeseed and mustard plants. Because high dietary consumption was found to cause fatty deposits in heart muscle in animal studies, food safety standards mandate the use of low-erucic acid varieties (such as canola oil) in commercial food production.

Alternate Names:
Erucic Acids; cis-13-Docosenoic Acid

Erucic Acids

Plural form; see *Erucic Acid*.

Eructation

Release of swallowed air or gas from the stomach through the mouth, commonly called belching. Frequent troublesome belching may be related to swallowed air, reflux, food intolerance, or other digestive problems.

Alternate Names:
Belching; Burping

Eruption Cyst

A soft, fluid-filled swelling over a tooth that is about to come through the gum, often blue or purple. It usually disappears when the tooth erupts, but painful or infected swelling needs dental review.

Eruptive Fever

Fever occurring with a widespread rash. Viral infections are common causes, but bacteria, medicines, allergic reactions, and immune disorders can also be responsible; severe illness or breathing difficulty may occur.

Eruptive Vellus Hair Cysts

Benign follicular cysts containing fine vellus hairs that appear as multiple small, smooth, red-brown or skin-colored papules, often on the chest, abdomen, or limbs. They may be inherited or sporadic and usually need treatment only for symptoms or cosmetic reasons.

Eruptive Xanthomas

Sudden crops of small yellow-red bumps, often on the buttocks, elbows, knees, or trunk, caused by very high blood triglycerides. They signal a serious lipid disorder requiring prompt evaluation and treatment.

Eruptive Xanthomatosis

A sudden outbreak of many small yellow-red skin bumps caused by fat collecting in skin immune cells. It is usually linked to very high triglycerides, sometimes from uncontrolled diabetes or an inherited lipid disorder.

Eryptosis

A controlled process by which aging or damaged red blood cells shrink and are marked for removal from the bloodstream. It helps maintain blood-cell balance but may increase in some diseases or during oxidative stress.

Erysipelas

An acute bacterial infection of the upper dermis and superficial lymphatic vessels, most often caused by group A streptococci. It typically produces a raised, sharply demarcated, warm, tender red patch, commonly on the face or lower leg, and may cause fever and chills.

Alternate Names:
St. Anthony's Fire (historical)

Erysipeloid

A skin infection caused by bacteria acquired through cuts while handling fish, meat, poultry, or animals. It usually causes a slowly expanding painful purple-red patch on a finger or hand and needs antibiotic treatment.

Erysipelothrix

A group of bacteria found in animals and animal products that can enter broken skin and cause a painful localized infection. Rarely, infection spreads to the bloodstream or heart valves.

Erythema

Redness of the skin or a moist body lining caused by increased blood flow near the surface. It may result from inflammation, infection, heat, allergy, or another illness and often fades briefly when pressed.

Erythema Ab Igne

A net-like red-brown skin discoloration caused by repeated exposure to moderate heat, such as heating pads, hot-water bottles, or heaters. Stopping the exposure may allow improvement; persistent lesions need examination.

Erythema Annulare Centrifugum

A reactive gyrate erythema presenting with slowly expanding, polycyclic, annular erythematous plaques characterized by central clearing and a distinctive trailing rim of fine scale along the inner border of the advancing erythematous margin.

Alternate Names:
EAC; Centrifugal Annular Erythema

Erythema Chronicum Migrans

An expanding skin rash that can appear days to weeks after a tick transmits Lyme disease bacteria. It may be evenly red or ring-shaped and does not always look like a classic bull's-eye.

Erythema Dose

The amount of ultraviolet or other radiation needed to produce visible skin redness. The minimal erythema dose is the smallest amount that causes a defined response and varies with skin type, medicines, and exposure conditions.

Erythema Dyschromicum Perstans

An acquired pigmentary disorder causing slowly spreading, sharply defined gray or blue-gray macules and patches, often on the face, neck, and trunk. Early lesions may have a reddish raised border; biopsy may help distinguish it from other causes of dermal hyperpigmentation, and treatment is often difficult.

Erythema Elevatum Diutinum

A rare chronic cutaneous leukocytoclastic vasculitis presenting as persistent, symmetrical, red-violaceous to yellowish-brown papules, nodules, and

plaques over the extensor surfaces of joints, associated with IgA paraproteinemia, hematologic disorders, and chronic infections.

Alternate Names:
EED; Chronic Extensor Leukocytoclastic Vasculitis

Erythema Gyratum Repens

A rapidly spreading, ringed skin rash with a wood-grain pattern. It is often associated with an internal cancer, especially of the lung, so new or persistent cases require prompt medical evaluation.

Erythema Induratum

A form of nodular vasculitis causing recurrent tender, sometimes ulcerating nodules on the backs of the lower legs. Biopsy shows lobular panniculitis with vasculitis; tuberculosis and other infections, inflammatory disease, venous problems, and medicines may be associated, so the cause should be investigated.

Erythema Infectiosum

An infection caused by human parvovirus B19, usually affecting children. Mild fever or cold-like symptoms may come first, followed by bright-red cheeks and a lacy rash on the trunk and limbs; adults may instead have joint pain. The virus can temporarily stop red-cell production, causing an aplastic crisis in people with chronic hemolytic disorders or prolonged anemia in those with weakened immunity. Infection during pregnancy can cause fetal anemia, hydrops, or pregnancy loss.

Erythema Infectiosum (Fifth Disease)

Alternate name; see *Erythema Infectiosum*.

Alternate Names:
Fifth Disease; Slapped Cheek Disease

Erythema Marginatum

A temporary, non-itchy, ring-shaped or wavy red rash that usually appears on the trunk and upper limbs. It is a recognized sign of acute rheumatic fever and may come and go over days or weeks.

Erythema Migrans

An expanding rash that develops days to weeks after a tick transmits Lyme disease bacteria. It may be uniformly red or ring-shaped and is usually diagnosed from its appearance and exposure history.

Erythema Multiforme

An acute skin reaction characterized by distinctive raised spots that resemble targets or bullseyes—with a dark central blister surrounded by a pale ring and an outer red border. Most commonly triggered by an underlying viral infection (particularly the herpes simplex virus) or certain medications, the lesions typically appear symmetrically on the hands, arms, feet, and face, and sometimes involve the lips or mouth.

Erythema Nodosum

An inflammatory skin condition that causes painful, tender, red or purplish bumps (nodules) in the fatty layer beneath the skin, most commonly along the front of the shins. It is an immune-mediated reaction triggered by various underlying causes, such as bacterial infections (like strep throat), inflammatory bowel disease, sarcoidosis, pregnancy, or certain medications.

Erythema Toxicum

A common harmless newborn rash with red spots, small bumps, or tiny pus-filled areas. It often appears during the first days of life and disappears on its own without treatment.

Erythema Toxicum Neonatorum

A harmless newborn rash that usually appears during the first few days as red blotches, bumps, or tiny pustules on the face, trunk, or limbs. It usually spares the palms and soles and clears within one to two weeks.

Alternate Names:
Erythema Neonatorum; Toxic Erythema of the Newborn

Erythrasma

A superficial bacterial infection in warm, moist skin folds that causes well-defined reddish-brown patches,

often in the groin, armpits, or between toes. It usually responds to prescribed antibacterial treatment and keeping folds dry.

Erythroblast

An immature red-blood-cell precursor made in the bone marrow. It develops through several stages before becoming a mature red blood cell; abnormal numbers may indicate altered blood-cell production.

Erythroblastosis Fetalis

Older name; see *Hemolytic Disease Of The Fetus And Newborn*.

Erythroblastosis Foetalis

Older name; see *Hemolytic Disease Of The Fetus And Newborn*.

Erythrocyte

A mature red blood cell that carries oxygen from the lungs to tissues and helps return carbon dioxide to the lungs. Its flexible shape allows it to pass through very small blood vessels.

Erythrocyte Alloimmunization and Pregnancy

Maternal antibodies directed against fetal red-cell antigens, commonly RhD, can cross the placenta and cause fetal or newborn hemolytic anemia. Blood-group screening, antibody testing, fetal surveillance, and preventive anti-D immunoglobulin when indicated reduce risk.

Erythrocyte Casts

Tube-shaped groups of red blood cells seen in urine. They form inside the kidney's small tubes and strongly suggest bleeding or inflammation in the kidney's filtering units, such as glomerulonephritis or vasculitis.

Alternate Names:
Red Blood Cell Casts; RBC Casts

Erythrocyte Enzyme Deficiency

An inherited or acquired lack of a protein that red blood cells need for energy or protection. The cells may break down too early and cause anemia; examples include G6PD and pyruvate-kinase deficiency.

Erythrocyte Membrane

The flexible outer layer of a red blood cell. It maintains the cell's shape, allows it to bend through small vessels, and controls movement of water and substances into and out of the cell.

Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate

A blood test measuring how quickly red blood cells settle in a tube over one hour. A faster rate can occur with inflammation, but it does not identify the cause and is affected by anemia, age, pregnancy, and other conditions.

Erythrocytosis

An increased red-cell concentration, reflected by elevated hemoglobin or hematocrit. It may be relative, from reduced plasma volume such as dehydration, or absolute, from increased red-cell mass due to a bone-marrow disorder or secondary stimulation such as low oxygen. The distinction affects interpretation and evaluation.

Erythroderma

Intense redness and usually scaling affecting about 90

Alternate Names:
Exfoliative Dermatitis; Exfoliative Erythroderma; Generalized Exfoliative Dermatitis

Erythrodermic Psoriasis

A rare, potentially life-threatening form of psoriasis causing nearly all the skin to become intensely red, painful, and scaly. Fever, chills, dehydration, infection, and unstable blood pressure may occur.

Erythrodysplasia

Abnormal development or maturation of red-blood-cell precursors in the bone marrow. It can produce ineffective blood formation and anemia and may occur with a marrow disorder or other illness.

Erythroid Hyperplasia

An increase in immature red-blood-cell precursors in the bone marrow, usually because the body is responding to anemia, blood loss, red-cell destruction, or low oxygen. The underlying cause needs evaluation.

Erythrokeratodermia Variabilis et Progressiva

A rare inherited keratinization disorder characterized by persistent, often symmetrical red and thickened scaly plaques together with more variable migrating erythematous patches. Onset is usually in infancy or childhood, and treatment aims to reduce scaling and inflammation with emollients, keratolytics, or specialist-directed retinoids.

Erythroleukemia

A rare acute myeloid leukemia characterized by prominent abnormal erythroid precursors in the bone marrow, often with dysplastic or immature myeloid cells. Diagnosis requires blood and marrow evaluation with immunophenotypic and genetic classification.

Erythroleukoplakia

A mouth lesion containing both red and white areas. It has a substantial risk of advanced precancerous change or cancer, so a dentist or specialist should examine it and usually perform a biopsy.

Erythromelalgia

Repeated attacks of burning pain, warmth, and redness in the feet, hands, or sometimes face, often triggered by heat or exercise and eased by cooling. It may be inherited or linked to blood or nerve disorders.

Erythromycin

An antibiotic that blocks bacterial protein production. It treats selected infections and can be used when some other antibiotics are unsuitable; nausea, diarrhea, liver injury, and abnormal heart rhythm are possible.

Erythromycin Estolate

An oral form of the antibiotic erythromycin. It blocks bacterial protein production and treats selected infections; stomach upset, liver inflammation, allergic reactions, and medicine interactions can occur.

Erythromycin Ophthalmic Prophylaxis

Antibiotic ointment placed in a newborn's eyes soon after birth to reduce the risk of severe eye infection from gonorrhea acquired during delivery. It does not replace testing and treatment of infections during pregnancy.

Erythroplakia

A lasting, well-defined red patch inside the mouth that is not explained by another condition. A tissue sample often shows severe precancerous cell changes or cancer.

Erythroplasia

A sharply bordered red patch on skin or a moist lining. Persistent lesions, especially in the mouth or genital area, may represent a serious precancerous change or cancer.

Erythroplasia Of Queyrat

Squamous-cell carcinoma in situ affecting the head of the penis or foreskin. It usually appears as a persistent, well-defined red or velvety patch and can progress to invasive cancer without treatment.

Erythropoiesis

The process of making mature red blood cells, mainly in the bone marrow. It is stimulated by erythropoietin when oxygen is low and requires healthy marrow plus adequate iron, vitamin B12, and folate.

Erythropoiesis-Stimulating Agents

Medicines that signal the bone marrow to make more red blood cells. They are used for selected anemias, including some caused by kidney disease or cancer treatment, but may increase blood pressure and clot risk.

Erythropoietin

A hormone made mainly by the kidneys when body tissues receive too little oxygen. It signals the bone marrow to produce red blood cells; kidney disease can reduce this signal and contribute to anemia.

Erythropoietin Deficiency

An insufficient amount of erythropoietin for the body's need, resulting in reduced stimulation of red-blood-cell production in the bone marrow. It commonly contributes to anemia in chronic kidney disease; reduced response to available erythropoietin is a separate phenomenon.

Erythropoietin Receptor

A protein on immature red-blood-cell precursors that receives the erythropoietin signal. Activation helps these cells survive, multiply, and mature into red blood cells.

Erythropoietin Test

A blood test measuring the kidney-made hormone that stimulates red-blood-cell production. It can help investigate selected anemias or high red-cell counts and is interpreted with the blood count, oxygen status, and kidney function.

Erythrosine

A red dye used in some foods, medicines, and laboratory procedures. Exposure is usually small, but regulations vary and people with a known sensitivity should follow product and medical advice.

ESBL

An enzyme made by some bacteria that destroys many penicillin and cephalosporin antibiotics. Infections caused by these bacteria can be harder to treat and require laboratory testing to select an effective medicine.

ESBL-Producing Organisms

Bacteria that make enzymes capable of breaking down many penicillin and cephalosporin antibiotics. They commonly include certain intestinal bacteria such as E. coli and Klebsiella; treatment depends on susceptibility testing and infection site.

Escape Reaction

A body response that restores an organ's activity after it has been reduced by a medicine, hormone, nerve signal, or feedback system. The response may lessen the effect of continued treatment or stimulation.

Eschar

A firm layer of dead tissue, often black or brown, over a burn, pressure injury, wound, infection, or area with poor blood supply. It can hide deeper damage and may need specialist assessment or removal.

Escharotomy

A surgical cut through stiff dead tissue around a deep burn to release pressure. It may restore circulation to a limb or allow the chest to expand, and is performed urgently when swelling threatens function.

Escherichia

A group of bacteria that includes E. coli and related species found in intestines or the environment. Some strains are harmless, while others cause diarrhea, urinary infection, wound infection, or bloodstream infection.

Escherichia Albertii

An uncommon intestinal bacterium that can cause diarrheal illness. It may be mistaken for certain E. coli strains, so specialized laboratory identification may be needed when infection is suspected.

Escherichia Blattae

A rarely reported Escherichia species associated mainly with insects and the environment. Its significance in a human sample is uncertain and must be judged from symptoms, the specimen source, and other test results.

Escherichia Coli

A bacterium that normally lives in the intestine. Some strains are harmless, while others cause urinary, intestinal, wound, or bloodstream infections, including severe bloody diarrhea and hemolytic ure-

mic syndrome.

Escherichia Coli Infection

Infection caused by a harmful strain of E. coli. It may affect the intestine, urinary tract, wounds, or bloodstream; symptoms, contagiousness, and treatment depend on the strain and site.

Escherichia Coli O157:H7 Infection

Infection with a toxin-producing E. coli strain, usually acquired from contaminated food, water, animals, or people. It commonly causes severe cramps and bloody diarrhea and can lead to kidney failure; urgent medical advice is important.

Escherichia Fergusonii

An uncommon bacterium that can occasionally cause urinary, wound, intestinal, or bloodstream infection, especially in people with serious illness or weakened immunity. Laboratory identification and susceptibility testing guide treatment.

Escherichia Hermannii

An uncommon Escherichia species that rarely causes opportunistic infection, including urinary or bloodstream infection. Its importance depends on the patient's symptoms, immune status, and the specimen in which it is found.

Escherichia Vulneris

An uncommon bacterium rarely linked to wound, urinary, or bloodstream infection, usually in people with other serious illnesses. A laboratory result requires clinical correlation to distinguish infection from contamination.

Escitalopram

An antidepressant that increases available serotonin in the brain. It treats depression and generalized anxiety disorder; nausea, sleep changes, sexual problems, withdrawal symptoms, bleeding risk, and rarely serotonin toxicity may occur.

ESKD

Severe permanent loss of kidney function, usually meaning kidney filtration below about 15 milliliters per minute or a need for dialysis or transplantation. It can cause fluid, electrolyte, anemia, and toxin problems and needs kidney-specialist care.

Esomeprazole

A medicine that reduces stomach-acid production by blocking the acid pump in stomach cells. It treats reflux, ulcers, and acid-related disorders; prolonged or inappropriate use may cause infections, low magnesium, or vitamin deficiencies.

Esomeprazole Magnesium

Drug salt; see *Esomeprazole*.

Esophageal

Relating to the esophagus, the muscular tube that carries swallowed food and liquid from the throat to the stomach.

Esophageal Achalasia

A disorder in which the lower esophageal valve does not relax properly and the esophagus cannot push food normally into the stomach. It causes difficulty swallowing, regurgitation, chest discomfort, and weight loss.

Esophageal Adenocarcinoma

A cancer arising from gland-forming cells, usually in the lower esophagus and often linked to Barrett esophagus. Reflux, obesity, and smoking increase risk; it may cause progressive swallowing difficulty or weight loss and is diagnosed by biopsy.

Esophageal Atresia

A birth defect in which the esophagus ends in a blind pouch instead of connecting normally to the stomach. A connection to the windpipe may also occur, causing drooling, choking, coughing, and breathing problems during feeds.

Esophageal Bleeding

Bleeding from the esophagus, which may result from enlarged veins, inflammation, ulcers, tears, injury, or cancer. Vomiting blood, passing black stools,

dizziness, or fainting requires emergency medical care.

Esophageal Cancer

A malignant tumor of the swallowing tube. The main types are squamous-cell cancer and adenocarcinoma; progressive difficulty swallowing, weight loss, pain, or bleeding may occur, and treatment depends on the stage.

Alternate Names:
Esophageal Carcinoma; Esophagus Malignancy

Esophageal Candidiasis

A yeast infection of the esophagus, more common with weakened immunity, diabetes, or certain medicines. It often causes painful or difficult swallowing and is treated with antifungal medicine, sometimes after endoscopy confirms it.

Esophageal Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Esophageal Cancer*.

Esophageal Culture

Laboratory growth testing on a sample from the esophagus to identify bacteria or fungi when infection is suspected. Results depend on how the sample was collected, symptoms, and endoscopic findings.

Esophageal Dilation

A procedure that gently stretches a narrowed area of the esophagus with a tube or balloon passed through an endoscope. It can improve swallowing caused by scarring, inflammation, injury, or other narrowing; tearing and bleeding are uncommon but serious risks.

Esophageal Diseases

Disorders affecting the swallowing tube between the throat and stomach. They include reflux, inflammation, narrowing, movement problems, cancer, infection, and birth defects, often causing swallowing difficulty, pain, heartburn, or regurgitation.

Esophageal Diverticulum

A pouch that bulges outward from the wall of the esophagus. It may cause difficulty swallowing, food coming back up, coughing, bad breath, or no symptoms; treatment depends on its size, location, and effects.

Esophageal Duplication

A rare birth defect consisting of a cyst or extra segment beside the esophagus. It may press on the esophagus or airway, causing swallowing difficulty, breathing problems, infection, or no symptoms.

Esophageal Fistula

An abnormal connection between the esophagus and another organ, often the airway. It can allow food or liquid into the lungs, causing coughing during swallowing, repeated pneumonia, poor nutrition, or severe illness.

Esophageal Foreign Body

Food or another object stuck in the esophagus, causing pain, difficulty swallowing, drooling, or breathing problems. A battery, sharp object, complete blockage, or suspected tear requires emergency removal.

Esophageal Infection

Infection of the esophagus caused by a yeast, virus, or bacterium, usually in people with weakened immunity or damaged lining. It may cause painful swallowing, difficulty swallowing, chest pain, or ulcers.

Esophageal Intramural Pseudodiverticulosis

A rare condition in which small drainage ducts of glands within the esophageal wall become widened. It may cause repeated swallowing difficulty, food impaction, or narrowing and is diagnosed with imaging or endoscopy.

Esophageal Leiomyoma

A usually benign smooth-muscle tumor arising in the esophageal wall. It may cause difficulty swallowing, chest discomfort, or no symptoms and is distinguished from other submucosal tumors with imaging, endoscopy, and tissue assessment when

needed.

Esophageal Leukoplakia

A persistent white patch on the esophageal lining caused by thickened surface cells. It is uncommon but may contain precancerous change, so evaluation and biopsy are often needed to determine its significance.

Esophageal Manometry

A test that measures pressure and muscle coordination in the esophagus during swallowing. A thin pressure-sensitive tube passes through the nose into the stomach and helps diagnose achalasia, spasm, and other movement disorders.

Esophageal Motility Disorder

A disorder of the muscle contractions or nerve control that moves food through the esophagus. It may cause difficulty swallowing, chest pain, regurgitation, or food sticking; testing may include esophageal manometry.

Esophageal Necrosis

Death of esophageal lining, sometimes producing a black appearance. It can result from severe low blood flow, shock, acid injury, or caustic substances and may lead to bleeding or perforation.

Esophageal Perforation

A hole through the full thickness of the esophageal wall, caused by forceful vomiting, an instrument, injury, or disease. It can release contents into the chest, causing severe infection and requiring emergency treatment.

Esophageal pH Monitoring

A test that records how much acid enters the esophagus, usually for 24 hours, using a thin tube or a small wireless sensor. It helps determine whether acid reflux explains persistent symptoms when the diagnosis is uncertain.

Esophageal Spasm

A condition affecting the esophagus (the muscular swallowing tube) marked by irregular, uncoordinated, or unusually forceful muscle contractions. Instead of moving food smoothly down toward the stomach, the esophagus contracts spastically, causing sudden severe chest pain that can mimic a heart attack, as well as difficulty or pain when swallowing food or liquids.

Alternate Names:
Esophageal Spasms; Diffuse Esophageal Spasm; DES

Esophageal Spasms

Plural form; see *Esophageal Spasm*.

Esophageal Squamous Cell Carcinoma

A cancer arising from the flat cells lining the esophagus, often in its upper or middle part. Smoking, heavy alcohol use, certain infections, and nutritional factors increase risk; diagnosis requires endoscopic biopsy.

Esophageal Stenosis

Narrowing of the passage through the esophagus caused by scarring, inflammation, a tumor, radiation, or a birth defect. It commonly causes progressively worsening difficulty swallowing, especially solid foods.

Esophageal Stent

A tube placed inside a narrowed or leaking esophagus to keep it open and allow swallowing. It is often used for cancer or injury; movement, blockage, bleeding, pain, or perforation can occur.

Esophageal Stricture

A narrowed area of the esophagus, commonly caused by acid reflux, caustic injury, inflammation, radiation, or procedures. It usually causes gradually worsening difficulty swallowing solids and may require stretching during endoscopy.

Esophageal Surgery

An operation on the esophagus or the area where it meets the stomach. It may treat cancer, severe narrowing, perforation, reflux, or movement disorders; the procedure and risks depend on the disease and

overall health.

Esophageal Ulceration

An open sore in the esophageal lining caused by reflux, infection, medicines, caustic injury, inflammation, or cancer. It may cause painful swallowing, chest pain, or bleeding and often requires endoscopic evaluation.

Esophageal Varices

Abnormally enlarged and swollen veins in the lower lining of the esophagus. They develop when normal blood flow to the liver is blocked—most commonly by advanced liver disease or cirrhosis—causing blood to back up into smaller collateral vessels that are not built to handle high pressure. Because these swollen veins have thin walls, they can rupture and cause sudden, massive, life-threatening vomiting of blood or black, tarry stools.

Alternate Names:
Esophageal Dilated Veins; Bleeding Esophageal Varices

Esophageal Web

A thin shelf of tissue projecting into the upper esophagus. It may cause difficulty swallowing solid food and can be associated with iron-deficiency anemia; persistent symptoms may require endoscopy.

Esophagectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the esophagus, usually for cancer or severe irreversible damage. The remaining digestive tract is reconstructed, commonly using the stomach or a segment of intestine.

Esophagitis

Inflammation or injury of the esophageal lining. Common causes include acid reflux, infection, medicines that irritate the esophagus, eosinophilic or other immune-mediated disease, swallowed irritants, and radiation. Symptoms may include heartburn, painful or difficult swallowing, chest pain, food sticking, or bleeding; persistent inflammation can cause ulcers or narrowing.

Esophagogastric Bypass

Surgery that creates a new route between the esophagus and stomach to restore passage of food, usually after esophageal removal or severe blockage. The method depends on anatomy, disease, and surgical goals.

Esophagogastric Junction

The area where the esophagus joins the stomach. Its muscular valve and surrounding structures help food enter the stomach while limiting backward flow of stomach contents.

Esophagogastric Tamponade

Temporary control of severe bleeding from esophageal or stomach veins by inflating a balloon device to apply pressure. It is a rescue measure used while definitive treatment is arranged and can obstruct breathing or cause aspiration.

Esophagogastroduodenoscopy

An upper endoscopic diagnostic and therapeutic procedure in which a thin, flexible video endoscope is passed through the mouth to examine the lining of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum.

Alternate Names:
EGD; Upper Endoscopy; Upper Gastrointestinal Endoscopy

Esophagoscope

A flexible or rigid instrument used to look inside the esophagus. It may allow a clinician to take tissue samples, remove a foreign object, treat bleeding, or perform another procedure.

Esophagoscopy

Examination of the esophagus with a camera-equipped instrument. It may investigate swallowing difficulty, bleeding, reflux damage, narrowing, foreign objects, infection, or suspected cancer and may allow treatment or biopsy.

Esophagram

An X-ray examination performed while a person swallows contrast liquid. It shows the shape and

movement of the esophagus and can reveal narrowing, leaks, pouches, blockage, or abnormal swallowing.

Esophagus

A muscular tube that carries food and liquid from the throat to the stomach. Coordinated muscle contractions move swallowed material downward, while valves at each end help limit reflux and air entry.

Esophagus Disease

A disorder of the esophagus causing swallowing difficulty, pain, reflux, regurgitation, bleeding, obstruction, inflammation, motility disturbance, or cancer.

Esophagus Neoplasm

A benign, precancerous, or malignant growth in the esophagus; evaluation may require endoscopy, biopsy, imaging, and staging.

Esotropia

A type of strabismus in which one or both eyes turn inward toward the nose. It may be constant or intermittent and can occur at any age. Causes include focusing or refractive problems, reduced vision, and disorders affecting eye-movement nerves or brain pathways; evaluation guides treatment.

ESR

The erythrocyte sedimentation rate, a nonspecific blood test measuring how quickly red cells settle in a tube; it can reflect inflammation but cannot identify its cause.

Alternate Names:
SED Rate

ESRD

Alternate index label; see *End-Stage Renal Disease*.

Essential

Necessary or fundamental; in a diagnosis such as essential hypertension, it indicates that no single secondary cause has been identified.

Essential Fats

Fatty acids the body cannot make in sufficient amounts and must obtain from food. They support cell membranes, skin, brain function, and production of signaling molecules involved in inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Essential Fatty Acids

Essential Fatty Acid

A fatty acid the body cannot make in sufficient amounts and therefore must obtain from food; the main human examples are linoleic acid and alpha-linolenic acid.

Essential Hypertension

Long-term high blood pressure with no single identifiable underlying cause. Many genetic, kidney, blood-vessel, metabolic, and lifestyle factors contribute, and untreated disease raises the risk of stroke, heart disease, kidney damage, and vision problems.

Essential Medicines

Medicines considered necessary to meet the most important health needs of a population. They are selected for proven benefit, safety, affordability, and practical availability and should be reliably accessible through healthcare services.

Essential Mixed Cryoglobulinemia

An immune disorder in which abnormal proteins in the blood thicken or clump in the cold and inflame small blood vessels. It may cause purple spots, joint pain, weakness, nerve problems, or kidney disease.

Essential Nutrient

A nutrient the body cannot make in sufficient amounts and must obtain from food or supplements. Essential nutrients include certain amino acids, fatty acids, vitamins, minerals, and water.

Essential Thrombocythemia

A long-term bone-marrow disorder that produces too many platelets. It can cause abnormal clotting or bleeding and may cause headaches, vision

changes, burning pain in fingers or toes, or no symptoms.

Essential Thrombocytosis

A chronic myeloproliferative neoplasm with persistent overproduction of platelets, often driven by JAK2, CALR, or MPL mutations. It can cause thrombosis, bleeding, microvascular symptoms, or splenomegaly.

Essential Tremor

A nervous-system disorder causing rhythmic shaking, usually of both hands during movement or when holding a position. It may also affect the head or voice, gradually worsen, and interfere with writing, eating, or other tasks. It can run in families but also occur without a family history.

Alternate Names:
Benign Essential Tremor; Familial Essential Tremor; Hereditary Essential Tremor

Essiac

A herbal mixture promoted as a treatment for cancer and other illnesses. Reliable evidence has not shown that it cures cancer, and its ingredients may interact with medicines or cause liver, kidney, or other harm.

Estazolam

A sedative medicine sometimes used short-term for insomnia. It slows brain activity but can cause daytime drowsiness, falls, memory problems, slowed breathing, dependence, and withdrawal; alcohol and opioids increase its dangers.

Ester

A chemical formed when an acid combines with an alcohol. Esters occur naturally in fats, medicines, and flavorings; their health effects depend on the specific compound, amount, route of exposure, and duration.

Esterase

An enzyme that breaks ester chemical bonds. Esterases help process fats, medicines, and other substances; abnormal activity or inhibition can alter drug effects and may contribute to poisoning.

Esterified Estrogens

A mixture of estrogen hormones used for selected menopausal symptoms or estrogen deficiency. Treatment can cause bleeding and increase risks of blood clots, stroke, and breast or uterine cancer, so benefits and risks must be individualized.

Esthesia

The ability to sense touch, pain, temperature, movement, or body position. Reduced, increased, or altered sensation may result from nerve injury, brain disease, medicines, or changes in consciousness.

Esthesiometer

An instrument used to measure sensitivity to touch, pressure, or other sensations. Eye clinicians may use one to assess corneal sensation when nerve injury or an eye-surface problem is suspected.

Esthesioneuroblastoma

A rare cancer arising from nerve-related cells high in the nasal cavity. It may cause blocked or bleeding nose, reduced smell, facial pain, or vision symptoms and is diagnosed with imaging and biopsy.

Estimated Average Glucose

An estimate of a person's average blood-glucose level calculated from the hemoglobin A1c result. It is reported in familiar glucose units but does not show daily highs, lows, or sudden changes.

Estimated Date Of Confinement

The approximate date when a pregnancy is expected to reach delivery, calculated from the last menstrual period or an early ultrasound. Only a small proportion of births occur on the estimated date.

Estimated Due Date

The approximate date of delivery, usually calculated as 40 weeks from the first day of the last menstrual period and adjusted when needed using an early ultrasound. Most births occur before or after this date.

Estimated Fetal Weight

An ultrasound-based estimate of a fetus's weight using measurements of the head, abdomen, and thigh bone. It helps assess growth and plan care, but commonly differs from actual birth weight by about 10–15 percent.

Estimated Glomerular Filtration Rate

An estimate of how well the kidneys filter blood, calculated mainly from blood creatinine and other factors. It helps assess kidney disease and adjust medicines but is less reliable during rapidly changing illness or unusual body size.

Estimation of Fetal Weight

An ultrasound-based estimate of fetal size using measurements such as head, abdominal, and femur dimensions. It helps assess growth and delivery planning but has an important margin of error and is interpreted with gestational age and clinical findings.

Estradiol

The main active estrogen hormone during most reproductive years. It helps regulate ovulation and menstruation and supports the vagina, uterus, bones, brain, and other tissues; levels fall after menopause.

Alternate Names:
17β-Estradiol

Estradiol Blood Test

A blood test measuring estradiol. It may help evaluate puberty, menstrual or fertility problems, ovarian or testicular function, menopause, or selected hormone disorders; results vary with age, sex, cycle timing, pregnancy, and medicines.

Estramustine

A cancer medicine combining an estrogen-like component with a compound that interferes with cell division. It has been used for selected advanced prostate cancers; blood clots, fluid retention, nausea, and heart effects may occur.

Estriol

An estrogen produced mainly by the placenta during pregnancy from substances made by the fetus and mother. Maternal blood estriol may be included in prenatal screening, but an abnormal result does not by itself diagnose a problem.

Estrogen

A class of steroid hormones synthesized primarily by the ovaries (granulosa and theca cells under FSH and LH stimulation) in premenopausal females, by the placenta during pregnancy, and to a lesser extent by the adrenal cortex, adipose tissue, and testes via peripheral aromatization of androgens (androstenedione and testosterone) by the enzyme aromatase. The major physiological estrogens are estradiol (E_2, the most potent and predominant estrogen during reproductive years), estrone (E_1, the predominant circulating estrogen post-menopause), estriol (E_3, produced in high concentrations by the feto-placental unit during pregnancy), and estetrol (E_4, produced exclusively by the fetal liver). Functioning by binding nuclear estrogen receptors (ERα and ERβ) to modulate target gene transcription, estrogens regulate the development of female secondary sexual characteristics, stimulate endometrial proliferation during the follicular phase of the menstrual cycle, maintain vaginal mucosal hydration, preserve bone mineral density by inhibiting osteoclast activity, promote favorable lipid profiles (elevating HDL, lowering LDL), and regulate vascular endothelial nitric oxide production. Exogenous estrogens are utilized in hormonal contraception and menopausal hormone therapy; unopposed estrogen exposure carries an increased risk of endometrial hyperplasia and adenocarcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Estrogens; Oestrogen

Estrogen Overdose

Taking or receiving more estrogen than prescribed. It may cause nausea, vomiting, breast tenderness, headache, or abnormal bleeding and can increase the risk of blood clots; urgent advice is needed after a large exposure.

Estrogen Receptor

A cell protein that binds estrogen and changes cell activity. Testing for estrogen receptors helps classify some cancers, especially breast cancer, and can guide hormone-based treatment.

Estrogen Replacement Therapy

Treatment supplying estrogen to relieve selected menopausal symptoms or replace deficient hormone. If the uterus is present, a progestogen is usually added to protect its lining; risks and benefits must be reviewed individually.

Estrogen-Replacement Therapy

Alternate spelling; see *Estrogen Replacement Therapy*.

Alternate Names:
Estrogen Therapy

Estrogens

Plural form; see *Estrogen*.

Estrogen Test

A blood, urine, or saliva test measuring one or more estrogen hormones. It may help evaluate puberty, menstrual problems, fertility, menopause, pregnancy, or hormone disorders; interpretation depends on the test type and timing.

Alternate Names:
Estrogen Levels Test Estrogen Blood Test

Estrone

A naturally occurring estrogen made partly by converting other hormones in body tissues. It is the main estrogen present after menopause, although estradiol is usually more active before menopause.

Estrous Cycle

The recurring reproductive cycle of many female mammals other than humans. It includes hormonal and physical changes that prepare for ovulation, mating, and possible pregnancy.

Eszopiclone

A sleep medicine that enhances inhibitory signaling in the brain. It can help insomnia but may cause drowsiness, impaired coordination, memory problems, dependence, unusual sleep behaviors, or a bitter taste.

Etacrynic Acid

A diuretic that makes the kidneys remove more salt and water, reducing swelling and sometimes blood pressure. It can cause dehydration, abnormal electrolytes, kidney problems, or hearing damage, especially at high doses.

Etanercept

A biologic medicine that blocks tumor-necrosis factor, an inflammation signal. It treats selected arthritis, psoriasis, and other inflammatory diseases but can increase serious infection risk, so tuberculosis and hepatitis screening may be needed.

Ethacrynic Acid

A loop diuretic that increases kidney excretion of salt and water. It can reduce fluid overload but may cause dehydration, low electrolytes, kidney injury, or dose-related hearing damage.

Ethambutol

An antibiotic used with other medicines to treat tuberculosis and selected infections caused by related bacteria. It can damage the optic nerve, causing blurred vision or trouble distinguishing colors, so vision testing is important.

Ethambutol Toxicity

A dose- and duration-dependent adverse pharmacological effect of the first-line antimycobacterial agent ethambutol, characterized by retrobulbar or axial optic neuritis, presenting with bilateral painless reduction in visual acuity, central scotomas, and loss of red-green color discrimination.

Ethane

A colorless, highly flammable gas used mainly to make industrial chemicals. It is not usually poisonous through direct action, but high concentrations can displace oxygen and cause suffocation or fire hazards.

Ethanol

The alcohol in alcoholic drinks and some disinfectants, medicines, and fuels. Drinking too much can impair judgment, suppress breathing, lower blood sugar, cause dependence, and damage the liver and other organs.

Ethanolamine

A chemical used in some industrial products, medicines, and cosmetic ingredients. Concentrated exposure can irritate or burn the skin, eyes, and airways; health effects depend on the product and amount of exposure.

Ethanol Metabolism

The body's breakdown of alcohol, mainly in the liver, into acetaldehyde and then acetate. The process affects blood-alcohol levels, drug interactions, intoxication, hangovers, and long-term alcohol-related organ damage.

Ethanol Poisoning

Harm from drinking a dangerous amount of alcohol, causing confusion, poor coordination, vomiting, slow or irregular breathing, low blood sugar, seizures, coma, or death. An unconscious or poorly breathing person needs emergency care.

Ether

A class of organic chemical compounds, historically represented by diethyl ether, a volatile, sweet-smelling liquid. Diethyl ether was famously introduced in the mid-19th century as one of the very first effective general anesthetics, allowing patients to undergo painless surgery, though it was later replaced by safer, non-flammable modern anesthetic agents.

Alternate Names:
Ethers; Diethyl Ether

Ethers

Plural form; see *Ether*.

Ethics

Principles used to decide what is right, fair, respectful, and responsible in healthcare and research. Medical ethics includes informed choice, privacy, avoiding harm, helping patients, and treating people fairly.

Ethinyl Estradiol

A synthetic estrogen used in many hormonal contraceptives and some other treatments. It can cause nausea or irregular bleeding and increases blood-clot risk, especially with smoking, migraine with aura, or certain medical conditions.

Ethiodized Oil

An iodine-containing oil used as a contrast material in selected imaging or treatment procedures, including some lymphatic and liver procedures. It can affect thyroid function or rarely enter blood vessels and cause an embolism.

Ethion

An organophosphate pesticide that can poison the nervous system by blocking acetylcholinesterase. Exposure may cause sweating, vomiting, pinpoint pupils, muscle twitching, weakness, breathing failure, or death.

Ethionamide

An antibiotic used with other medicines for drug-resistant or difficult-to-treat tuberculosis. It interferes with mycobacterial cell-wall production and may cause nausea, liver injury, nerve symptoms, or thyroid problems.

Ethmocephaly

A severe birth defect in which the eyes are very close together and the nose is replaced or accompanied by a tube-like structure. It usually occurs with major brain-development abnormalities and is often life-limiting.

Ethmoidal Air Cells

Multiple small air-filled spaces within the ethmoid bone between the nose and eye sockets. They are part of the sinus system and can become blocked or infected, causing sinus pressure and discharge.

Ethmoidal Sinus

A group of small, thin-walled air spaces in the ethmoid bone between the eye sockets and above the nasal cavity. They are divided into front and back groups according to where they drain.

Alternate Names:
Ethmoid Air Cells; Paranasal Ethmoid Sinus

Ethmoid Bone

A light, complex bone between the eye sockets that forms part of the nasal septum, nasal roof, and inner eye socket. It contains air cells and openings for smell nerves, so injury can affect smell or the eye.

Ethmoiditis

Alternate name; see *Ethmoid Sinusitis*.

Ethmoid Sinus

One of several small air spaces in the ethmoid bone between the nose and eye sockets. Inflammation or infection can cause nasal blockage, headache, or eye-area pain and may spread to nearby tissues.

Ethmoid Sinusitis

Inflammation or infection of the air spaces between the nose and eyes. It may cause congestion, discharge, fever, headache, or pain around the eyes; eye swelling, vision changes, or severe illness may indicate orbital or intracranial complications.

Ethnicity

A social and cultural identity shaped by shared ancestry, history, language, traditions, or community; it is not a biological diagnosis and should not be used as a substitute for individual risk assessment.

Ethoglucid

An older sclerosing substance used historically to treat selected vascular lesions or hemorrhoids; modern use is limited by tissue-injury risks and alternatives.

Ethosuximide

An anticonvulsant used mainly for absence seizures; common adverse effects include gastrointestinal symptoms, fatigue, and headache, with rare blood or skin reactions.

Ethoxzolamide

A carbonic-anhydrase-inhibiting medicine that reduces formation of certain body fluids. It has been used for selected eye and metabolic conditions; possible effects include tingling, nausea, kidney stones, and electrolyte changes.

Ethyl Chloride

A volatile liquid sprayed on skin to produce brief cooling and numbness before minor procedures, but misuse can cause cold injury or toxicity.

Ethylene

A colorless, flammable gas used in chemical manufacturing and to ripen fruit. High concentrations can displace oxygen and cause headache, dizziness, drowsiness, unconsciousness, or suffocation. Exposure in a poorly ventilated space can be life-threatening.

Ethylene Chlorohydrin

A toxic industrial chemical used in some manufacturing processes. Exposure can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways and may affect the nervous system, liver, or kidneys. It can be absorbed through skin, so contaminated clothing should be removed safely and urgent poison-control advice obtained.

Ethylene Dibromide

A toxic chemical formerly used as a soil fumigant and fuel additive. It can irritate the eyes and lungs and may damage the liver, kidneys, or nervous system; long-term exposure is associated with cancer risk.

Ethylene Glycol

A toxic alcohol found in some antifreeze and industrial products. Ingestion can cause severe metabolic acidosis, neurologic impairment, kidney injury, and death.

Ethylene Glycol Blood Test

A blood test measuring ethylene glycol, a toxic alcohol found in some antifreeze products. Detection supports diagnosis of poisoning, but treatment must not wait for the result when the exposure and metabolic findings are strongly suggestive.

Ethylene Glycol Poisoning

Poisoning after swallowing ethylene glycol, found in some antifreeze products. Early effects may resemble alcohol intoxication, followed by severe acid buildup, seizures, coma, and kidney failure; emergency antidote and sometimes dialysis are needed.

Ethylene Glycol Toxicity

Poisoning by ethylene glycol, a toxic alcohol found in some antifreeze products. It can cause alcohol-like drowsiness, severe acid buildup in the blood, seizures, coma, and kidney injury. Treatment may include the antidote fomepizole and dialysis, depending on the severity.

Ethylene Oxide

A flammable gas used to sterilize heat-sensitive medical equipment and make other chemicals. It can irritate the skin and airways, cause nerve injury, and with repeated exposure increase cancer risk. Sterilized equipment must be adequately aerated before use, and workplace exposure requires strict controls.

Ethyl Ether

A highly flammable liquid formerly used as an anesthetic and still used as a laboratory solvent. Breathing its vapor can cause irritation, dizziness, drowsiness, or loss of consciousness; swallowing it can injure the lungs if it is aspirated. Exposure requires fresh air, fire precautions, and medical assessment when symptoms are severe.

Ethynodiol Diacetate

A synthetic progestogen formerly used in some oral contraceptives. It helps prevent pregnancy mainly by suppressing ovulation and changing cervical mucus and the uterine lining.

Etidronic Acid

A medicine related to bisphosphonates that can slow the breakdown of bone by attaching to bone mineral. It has also been used to bind minerals in some nonmedical products; effects and safety depend on the use and dose.

Etilefrine

A medicine that stimulates some of the body's adrenaline-like receptors and can raise blood pressure. It increases blood-vessel tightening and heart activity, so it may cause fast heartbeat, headache, or other effects and requires medical supervision.

Etiology

The cause or set of causes of a disease or health condition, including genetic, infectious, environmental, immune, traumatic, and behavioural factors.

Etodolac

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain and inflammation; gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, cardiovascular events, and hypersensitivity are important risks.

Etomidate

A short-acting intravenous anesthetic used for induction, particularly when cardiovascular stability is desired; it can cause myoclonus, nausea, and transient adrenal suppression.

Etonogestrel

A man-made form of the hormone progesterone used in a small contraceptive implant placed under the skin of the upper arm. It mainly prevents ovulation and also thickens cervical mucus; irregular bleeding and other hormone-related effects can occur.

Etoposide

A chemotherapy medicine that interferes with DNA repair and cell division. It treats several cancers but can cause low blood counts, infection, hair loss, nausea, mouth sores, or a later risk of leukemia.

Etoposide Phosphate

A water-soluble form of etoposide that changes into etoposide inside the body. It provides another method of giving the chemotherapy medicine, with similar cancer treatment effects and potential toxicities.

Etoricoxib

An anti-inflammatory pain medicine that selectively blocks an enzyme involved in pain and swelling. It may help arthritis or acute pain but can raise blood pressure and increase heart, kidney, fluid-retention, and stomach risks.

Eubacterium

A group of bacteria that usually live without oxygen in the mouth and intestine. Most are part of normal microbial communities, but some can rarely cause opportunistic infection in seriously ill people.

Eubacterium Limosum

A bacterium that lives without oxygen in the intestine and helps break down nutrients. It is rarely associated with human infection, and its importance in a sample depends on symptoms and the collection site.

Eubacterium Rectale

A common intestinal bacterium that helps ferment dietary fiber and produce short-chain fatty acids. These products support the colon and contribute to normal gut microbial activity.

Eucalyptus Oil

A concentrated plant oil containing eucalyptol and other chemicals. Swallowing it can poison the nervous system and cause vomiting, drowsiness, seizures, or breathing problems; it should not be taken internally without medical advice.

Eucalyptus Oil Overdose

Poisoning after swallowing eucalyptus oil. It can cause burning, vomiting, drowsiness, confusion, seizures, or breathing problems; severe cases may be life-threatening.

Euchromatin

A relatively open form of DNA packaging inside the cell nucleus. Its structure makes nearby genes more accessible for reading and activity than DNA in tightly packed regions.

Eugenicist

A person who supports eugenics, a discredited belief that society should control reproduction to alter inherited traits in a population. Eugenic policies caused coercion, discrimination, and forced sterilization and have no place in ethical healthcare.

Eugenics

A discredited ideology that seeks to change a population by encouraging some people to reproduce and preventing others from doing so. Its history includes racism, forced sterilization, institutional abuse, and genocide.

Eugenol Oil Overdose

Poisoning after excessive exposure to clove-derived eugenol oil. It may irritate the mouth and stomach and cause liver injury, bleeding, seizures, low blood pressure, slowed breathing, or coma.

Euglycemic Diabetic Ketoacidosis

A form of diabetic ketoacidosis in which the blood glucose is below 200 mg/dL despite high ketone levels and acid buildup in the blood. It may occur with sodium-glucose cotransporter 2 (SGLT2) medicines, reduced food intake, or acute illness.

Alternate Names:
EuDKA; Normal Glycemic Ketoacidosis

Euphoria

An unusually intense feeling of happiness or well-being. It may occur normally, with mania, brain disease, or some medicines and drugs; sudden extreme euphoria with unsafe behavior needs clinical assessment.

Eustachian Tube

A passage connecting the middle ear to the back of the nose. It opens during swallowing or yawning to

equalize pressure, drain fluid, and help protect the middle ear from throat secretions.

Eustachian Tube Dysfunction

A problem with the passage connecting the middle ear to the back of the nose. If it does not open or close properly, pressure or fluid can build up and cause ear fullness, popping, muffled hearing, or pain, often after a cold, allergy, or pressure change.

Eustachian-Tube Dysfunction

Alternate spelling; see *Eustachian Tube Dysfunction*.

Eustachian Tube Patency

The ability of the passage between the middle ear and back of the nose to remain open enough to equalize pressure and drain fluid. Poor patency can cause fullness, muffled hearing, or middle-ear fluid.

Eustachian Tube Problems

Problems with the ear-to-nose passage can cause fullness, popping, pain, muffled hearing, or repeated middle-ear fluid or infection. Colds, allergies, inflammation, and anatomy may contribute; persistent hearing loss needs examination.

Alternate Names:
Eustachian Tube Dysfunction (ETD); Auditory Tube Obstruction

Eustachian Valve

A crescentic embryological flap of tissue at the junction of the inferior vena cava and the inferior right atrium that in fetal life directs oxygenated umbilical venous blood across the foramen ovale into the left atrium; usually persists as a benign vestigial remnant in adults.

Alternate Names:
Valve of the Inferior Vena Cava

Euthanasia

The deliberate ending of a person's life by another person to relieve suffering. It is ethically and legally distinct from allowing a natural death, stopping unwanted treatment, or providing comfort-focused palliative care.

Euthanasia And Assisted Dying

Terms describing legally regulated practices intended to end life or help a person end life to relieve suffering. Laws and safeguards differ widely; they are distinct from palliative care and withdrawal of unwanted treatment.

Euthyroid

Having normal thyroid function, usually shown by thyroid-stimulating hormone and thyroid-hormone levels within the laboratory's reference ranges. A person can be euthyroid even when another illness temporarily changes some thyroid test results.

Euthyroid Goiter

An enlarged thyroid gland with normal thyroid-hormone production. It may result from iodine imbalance, autoimmune disease, nodules, medicines, or inherited factors and may be persistent, enlarging, or cause swallowing or breathing problems.

Euthyroid Hyperthyroxinemia

Elevated circulating thyroxine with an otherwise euthyroid clinical state. Binding-protein changes, inherited transport abnormalities, assay interference, or medication effects can produce the laboratory pattern without true thyroid hormone excess.

Euthyroid Sick Syndrome

Temporary changes in thyroid blood tests during severe illness, starvation, or major surgery without a primary thyroid disorder. Treatment usually focuses on the underlying illness rather than thyroid hormone.

Eutocia

Normal labor and birth progressing without major obstruction or complication. The term describes the course of delivery, not a separate disease or treatment.

Euvolemic Hyponatremia

Low blood sodium with no obvious clinical signs

of excess or deficient body fluid volume. Common mechanisms include inappropriate antidiuretic hormone activity, adrenal insufficiency, hypothyroidism, and excess water intake.

Evacuation

In medicine, removal of material from a body cavity, organ, or wound, such as blood from a body space or retained tissue from the uterus. In general use, it also means moving people away from danger.

Evacuation Of Uterus

Removal of pregnancy tissue or other retained material from the uterus using medicines, suction, or a surgical procedure. It may treat miscarriage, abortion, retained placenta, or bleeding and carries risks of infection, bleeding, or uterine injury.

Evaluation of Fetal Death

Assessment after suspected or confirmed fetal death includes ultrasound confirmation, maternal examination, laboratory testing, review of medical and pregnancy history, and discussion of placental or fetal examination when appropriate. Care also addresses delivery, bleeding or infection risk, grief, and future-pregnancy planning.

Evans Syndrome

An autoimmune disorder characterized by the simultaneous or sequential development of autoimmune hemolytic anemia (positive direct antiglobulin test) and immune thrombocytopenic purpura, occasionally accompanied by autoimmune neutropenia.

Alternate Names:
Evans's Syndrome; AIHA and ITP Syndrome

Event-Free Survival

The length of time after treatment begins or a study starts before a defined event occurs, such as disease progression, relapse, a complication, or death. The exact event must be stated for comparisons to be meaningful.

Event Monitor

A portable device that records the heart's electrical rhythm when symptoms occur or at scheduled intervals over days or weeks. It can help detect intermittent abnormal rhythms that a brief ECG may miss.

Everolimus

A medicine that suppresses a cell-growth pathway and immune activity. It is used for selected cancers, transplant care, and some genetic disorders; mouth sores, infection, high blood sugar, lung inflammation, and low blood counts may occur.

Eversion

Turning the sole of the foot outward, away from the body's midline. The movement uses several ankle and foot joints and can be limited by injury, arthritis, or nerve and muscle disorders.

Evidence-Based Practice

Care that combines the best available research, professional clinical judgment, and the patient's goals, values, and circumstances. It supports informed decisions while recognizing that evidence and individual needs may differ.

Eviscerate

1. To remove internal organs from the body, or the contents of an organ, such as the eye. 2. For internal organs to protrude through an open wound or surgical incision.

Evisceration

Protrusion of internal organs through a surgical abdominal wound that has opened. It is a surgical emergency because exposed organs can be injured, contaminated, or lose blood supply.

Evoked Potential

An electrophysiological neurodiagnostic recording of the electrical potential generated by the central nervous system in response to deliberate, synchronized sensory stimulation. Evaluates the functional integrity and conduction velocity of specific sensory neural pathways through the peripheral nerves, spinal cord tracts, brainstem nuclei, and cerebral cortex. Major clinical modalities include: Visual Evoked Potentials (VEP, recorded over the occipi-

tal cortex following checkerboard pattern-reversal visual stimuli, measuring the P100 wave latency to detect subclinical demyelinating optic neuritis in multiple sclerosis); Brainstem Auditory Evoked Potentials (BAEP, recorded over the scalp following auditory clicks, generating five distinct positive wave peaks representing the auditory nerve to the inferior colliculus to evaluate acoustic neuromas and brainstem lesions); and Somatosensory Evoked Potentials (SSEP, recorded over the spine and sensory cortex following electrical stimulation of the median or tibial nerves, widely utilized for intraoperative neurophysiological monitoring during spinal and cranial surgery).

Alternate Names:
Evoked Potentials; Evoked Response

Evoked Potentials

Plural form; see *Evoked Potential*.

Evolution

Gradual change in inherited traits of a population across generations. In clinical writing, the term can also describe how a disease, symptom, or treatment response changes over time.

Evolutionarily Conserved Gene

A gene whose sequence or function remains similar across different species. This similarity suggests that the gene performs an important biological role, although it does not by itself prove a disease association.

Ewart Sign

A physical-examination finding of a large fluid collection around the heart: dullness, reduced breath sounds, and bronchial breathing over the lower left back. Modern imaging is more reliable for confirming the cause.

Ewing Sarcoma

A rare, aggressive cancer of bone or soft tissue, most often affecting children, teenagers, and young adults. It may cause persistent pain, swelling, fever, or a fracture and requires biopsy and specialist treatment.

Ewing's Family of Tumors

Alternate name; see *Ewing Sarcoma*.

Ewing's Family of Tumors

Alternate name; see *Ewing Sarcoma*.

Ewing's Sarcoma

Alternate name; see *Ewing Sarcoma*.

Ewing's Tumour

Alternate spelling; see *Ewing Sarcoma*.

Exacerbate

To make a disease, symptom, or medical problem worse. Infection, stress, exertion, allergens, medicines, or delayed treatment may exacerbate symptoms, depending on the condition.

Exacerbation

A worsening or flare of a disease or its symptoms after a period of relative stability. Triggers may include infection, allergens, treatment interruption, exertion, or another physical or emotional stress.

Exacerbation Of COPD

A sudden worsening of breathlessness, cough, or sputum beyond usual daily variation in chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. Infections and air pollution are common triggers; severe breathlessness, confusion, or blue lips may occur in severe exacerbations.

Exaggerated Placental Site

A noncancerous increase in placental cells at the place where the placenta attaches to the uterus. It may resemble a pregnancy-related cancer in a tissue sample, so an experienced pathologist must distinguish it from cancer.

Examination

A systematic assessment of health using observation, touch, listening, measurements, and selected tests. It may be general or focused on a complaint and helps identify normal findings, illness, injury, and urgency.

Examination Table

A padded, adjustable surface that supports a person during examination, testing, minor procedures, or treatment. It should be stable, cleanable, accessible, and used with appropriate safety measures.

Exanthem

A widespread skin rash, often caused by an infection or medicine. Its appearance, timing, fever, mucosal involvement, and other symptoms help clinicians determine whether it may be contagious or serious.

Exanthema

A widespread skin eruption associated with an illness affecting the body. Viral infections are common causes, but medicines, bacteria, and immune disorders may also cause it; blisters, skin pain, mouth sores, or severe illness need prompt assessment.

Exanthema Subitum

Alternate spelling; see *Exanthem Subitum*.

Exanthematous Pustulosis

A sudden medicine-related eruption of many small, noninfectious pustules on red skin, often with fever. It usually improves after the responsible medicine is withdrawn; severe reactions may have systemic effects.

Exanthem Subitum

A common viral illness in infants and toddlers, usually caused by human herpesvirus 6 or 7. It often causes three to five days of high fever followed by a pink rash as the fever settles.

Alternate Names:
Roseola Infantum; Sixth Disease

Excavation

A hollow, depression, or removal of tissue or material. In medicine it may describe a normal body feature, a disease-related defect, or the surgical creation or clearing of a space.

Exceptional Release

Permission to use a donated organ that does not meet usual acceptance criteria when clinicians judge it suitable for a particular recipient. The decision requires careful risk assessment, documentation, and informed consent.

Excessive Bruising

Bruises that occur often, are unusually large, appear without clear injury, or last unusually long. Causes include medicines, fragile skin, low platelets, clotting disorders, liver disease, or other illness.

Excessive Daytime Sleepiness

An excessive tendency to feel drowsy or fall asleep during waking hours, despite an opportunity for adequate nighttime sleep. It may occur with insufficient sleep, sleep disorders, medicines, medical or neurologic conditions, or mood disorders.

Excessive Menstrual Bleeding

Alternate name; see *Heavy Menstrual Bleeding*.

Excessive Scarring

Abnormal overgrowth of scar tissue during wound healing. A hypertrophic scar remains within the original wound, while a keloid grows beyond its edges.

Excessive Sweating

Sweating more than needed to cool the body, either all over or in specific areas such as the hands, feet, or armpits. It may result from hyperhidrosis, medicines, infection, hormones, or another illness.

Excessive Tearing

Tears overflowing onto the face because the eyes make too many tears or drainage is blocked. Irritation, allergy, infection, dry eye, eyelid problems, or a blocked tear duct may be responsible.

Excessive Thirst

Polydipsia, an abnormally strong or persistent desire to drink, commonly associated with dehydration, diabetes mellitus, diabetes insipidus, medicines, or psychiatric conditions.

Excessive Yawning

Excessive yawning is unusually frequent or difficult-to-control yawning. It may accompany sleep deprivation, excessive daytime sleepiness, medication effects, vasovagal reactions, or less commonly neurologic or cardiopulmonary disease; persistent unexplained episodes merit clinical evaluation.

Excess Post-Exercise Oxygen Consumption

Increased oxygen use after exercise as the body returns to its usual metabolic and physiologic state.

Exchange Transfusion

A procedure that repeatedly removes small amounts of a baby's blood and replaces them with compatible donor blood. It can rapidly reduce dangerous bilirubin or antibody-related anemia when other treatment is insufficient.

Excise

To remove tissue, a growth, or a lesion by cutting it out. The removed material may be examined in a laboratory to identify the cause and determine whether abnormal cells reach the edges.

Excision

Surgical removal of part or all of a lesion, tissue, or organ. The specimen may be examined to establish a diagnosis, and removal may also treat disease when the affected area can be safely removed.

Excisional Biopsy

Removal of an entire lump or abnormal area, sometimes with a small margin of nearby tissue, so a laboratory can examine it. It may provide a diagnosis and, for selected small lesions, complete treatment.

Excision Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Excisional Biopsy*.

Excitation

Activation or increased responsiveness of a cell, nerve, muscle, molecule, or body system after a stimulus. In nerves and muscles, it can start electrical signals that produce movement or other functions.

Excitation-Contraction Coupling

The chain of events that links an electrical signal in a muscle cell to contraction. The signal causes calcium release inside the cell, allowing muscle proteins to interact and generate force.

Excitatory Neurotransmitter

A chemical messenger that makes a receiving nerve cell more likely to generate an electrical signal. Examples include glutamate and, in some settings, acetylcholine; excessive activity can injure nerve cells.

Excitatory Synapse

A junction between nerve cells where chemical signaling makes the receiving cell more likely to produce an electrical impulse. Balanced excitatory and inhibitory signals are needed for normal brain and nerve function.

Excitotoxicity

The pathological process of neuronal injury and cell death resulting from excessive or prolonged synaptic stimulation by excitatory neurotransmitters, primarily glutamate, triggering massive intracellular calcium influx, mitochondrial dysfunction, reactive oxygen species generation, and apoptotic protease activation.

Excitotoxin

A substance that overstimulates nerve cells and can damage or kill them. Excessive signaling may allow too much calcium into cells, contributing to injury in some brain diseases or poisoning states.

Exclamation Point Hair

A short broken hair that is thinner at its outer end and wider near the scalp. It is a characteristic finding of alopecia areata but can occasionally appear in other hair disorders.

Exclusion Diet

A planned diet that removes a suspected food and later reintroduces it to see whether symptoms recur. It should be supervised when possible and must not replace emergency allergy evaluation when severe reactions or anaphylaxis are possible.

Excoriate

To remove or injure the skin surface by scratching, rubbing, or picking. Repeated excoriation can cause open sores, infection, scarring, and difficulty healing.

Excoriation

A superficial skin injury caused by scratching, rubbing, or picking. It may cause pain, bleeding, crusting, infection, or scarring and usually heals when the irritation or behavior stops.

Excoriation Disorder

An obsessive-compulsive and related disorder involving recurrent skin picking that causes lesions, scarring, infection, or other tissue damage. Repeated attempts to reduce or stop the picking are unsuccessful, and the behavior causes significant distress or impairment; it is not better explained by a skin disease, substance, or another mental disorder.

Alternate Names:
Skin-Picking Disorder

Excoriation Disorder (Skin-Picking Disorder)

Alternate name; see *Excoriation Disorder*.

Excreta

Material expelled from the body, including stool, urine, sweat, vomit, and respiratory secretions. Some excreta carry infectious organisms, so handwashing, protective equipment, cleaning, and safe disposal help prevent spread.

Excretion

Removal of waste, medicines, or other substances from the body, mainly through urine, bile, breath, stool, sweat, or breast milk. Kidney and liver function strongly affect how long many substances remain in the body.

Executive Function

A multidimensional suite of higher-order top-down cognitive neurobehavioral control processes mediated predominantly by the prefrontal cortex (including dorsolateral, ventromedial, orbitofrontal, and anterior cingulate cortices) and its extensive frontostriatal and thalamocortical networks. These integrative operations enable goal-directed, purposeful, adaptive, and flexible behavior in novel or complex situations. Core subcomponents include working memory (mental manipulation and online maintenance of information), cognitive flexibility/set-shifting (the capacity to switch perspectives, attention, or strategies in response to changing environmental demands), and inhibitory control (suppression of prepotent impulsive behaviors, distractions, or inappropriate automatic actions). Higher-level executive functions encompass reasoning, abstract problem-solving, cognitive planning, organized strategy formulation, and error monitoring. Executive dysfunction (dysexecutive syndrome) is a prominent feature of frontotemporal lobar degeneration, traumatic brain injury, stroke affecting the frontal lobes or basal ganglia, Parkinson disease, attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), and schizophrenia.

Alternate Names:
Executive Functions; Executive Control; Frontal Lobe Function

Executive Function Deficit

Impairment in higher-level cognitive processes governed by the frontal lobes, including working memory, planning, cognitive flexibility, organization, and impulse control; see *Executive Function*.

Executive Functions

Plural form; see *Executive Function*.

Exemestane

A medicine that lowers estrogen production by blocking an enzyme used after menopause. It treats selected hormone-sensitive breast cancers and may cause hot flushes, joint pain, bone loss, fatigue, or

abnormal cholesterol.

Exenatide

An injectable medicine that imitates a gut hormone, increasing insulin release when glucose is high, reducing glucagon, and slowing stomach emptying. It treats type 2 diabetes but may cause nausea, dehydration, or pancreatitis.

Exencephaly

A severe birth defect in which much of the developing brain lies outside the skull because the skull and protective coverings did not form normally. It usually progresses to anencephaly and is not compatible with long-term survival.

Exenteration

Extensive surgery removing organs and tissues from a body compartment, such as the pelvis or eye socket. It is reserved for selected advanced cancers or destructive disease and can cause major functional and emotional effects.

Exercise

Planned physical activity intended to improve or maintain strength, endurance, flexibility, balance, function, or health. Aerobic, resistance, and balance activities should be chosen and increased according to a person's abilities and medical risks.

Alternate Names:
Physical Exercise

Exercise And Age

The way physical activity needs and responses may change with age; safe exercise should match fitness, health, and ability.

Exercise And Immunity

The relationship between physical activity and immune function; regular moderate activity generally supports health, while excessive exertion may increase short-term illness risk.

Exercise Headaches

Headaches occurring during or after strenuous physical activity. Primary exercise headaches are recurrent and usually not caused by an underlying disorder, but a first, abrupt, severe, or atypical exertional headache requires prompt medical assessment to exclude secondary causes such as subarachnoid hemorrhage, arterial dissection, or reversible cerebral vasoconstriction syndrome.

Exercise-Induced Anaphylaxis

A rare form of anaphylaxis triggered by physical exertion, sometimes only when exercise follows ingestion of a specific food or medicine. Symptoms may include flushing, hives, swelling, wheezing, gastrointestinal symptoms, low blood pressure, or collapse.

Exercise-Induced Arrhythmias

Abnormal heart rhythms that begin or worsen during physical exertion. They may result from inherited electrical disorders, heart muscle disease, or reduced blood flow; fainting, chest pain, or palpitations may accompany them.

Exercise-Induced Asthma

An older, imprecise name for exercise-induced bronchoconstriction, which is temporary airway narrowing during or after exercise and can occur with or without chronic asthma.

Exercise-Induced Bronchoconstriction

Temporary narrowing of the lower airways during or shortly after exercise, with or without underlying asthma. It may cause cough, wheezing, chest tightness, or breathlessness, and is more likely in cold, dry air. Diagnosis is confirmed by an objective fall in lung function after exercise or a surrogate bronchoprovocation challenge.

Alternate Names:
Exercise-Induced Asthma (legacy term)

Exercise Intolerance

An inability to do as much physical activity as expected because of unusual tiredness, breathlessness, chest discomfort, leg pain, weakness, or dizziness. Heart, lung, blood-vessel, muscle, nerve, blood, metabolic, and conditioning problems can cause it.

Exercise Prescription

An individualized physical-activity plan specifying the type, frequency, intensity, duration, and progression of exercise. It is adapted to a person's goals, fitness, medical conditions, symptoms, and safety needs.

Exercises To Help Prevent Falls

Activities that improve leg strength, balance, flexibility, walking, and confidence. A program should match ability and medical conditions; supervised practice may be safest for people with previous falls or severe weakness.

Exercise Stress Test

A test that records heart rate, rhythm, blood pressure, and symptoms while a person walks on a treadmill or pedals a stationary bicycle. It assesses exercise capacity and may suggest reduced heart blood flow or an abnormal rhythm.

Exercise Tolerance

The ability to perform physical activity before symptoms such as breathlessness, fatigue, chest discomfort, or pain limit activity.

Exfoliation Syndrome

An age-related eye disorder in which abnormal material collects on the lens and other front-eye structures. It increases the risk of glaucoma and can make cataract surgery more complicated, so regular eye checks are important.

Exfoliative Cytology

Examination of cells that naturally shed from a body surface or are gently collected. It may help investigate infection, inflammation, or cancer, but abnormal or uncertain results may require tissue biopsy.

Exfoliative Dermatitis

Alternate name; see *Erythroderma*.

Exhalation

Breathing air out of the lungs. It is usually passive at rest as the lungs recoil, but muscles actively assist exhalation during exercise, coughing, or breathing difficulty.

Exhaled Nitric Oxide

A breath test that estimates one type of airway inflammation. A raised result can support asthma assessment and suggest likely benefit from inhaled steroids, but smoking, infection, allergies, and current treatment can affect the result.

Exhaustion

Extreme physical or mental tiredness that reduces the ability to function. It may follow exertion, poor sleep, illness, dehydration, anemia, hormone disorders, medicines, or stress; severe or persistent symptoms need evaluation.

Exhibitionism

Sexual arousal from exposing one's genitals to an unsuspecting person. Repeated nonconsensual exposure can harm others and becomes a diagnosable disorder when urges or actions cause significant distress, impairment, or risk.

Exhibitionistic Disorder

A mental-health disorder involving repeated sexual arousal from exposing the genitals to an unsuspecting person, with action on the urges or clinically significant distress or impairment.

Exhumation

Lawful removal of a buried body or remains for identification, further testing, investigation, or repatriation. It requires legal authorization and respectful handling; testing may include toxicology, DNA analysis, or examination of injuries.

Existential Distress

Emotional suffering related to meaning, identity, purpose, freedom, mortality, or loss of control. It can occur during serious illness and may improve with empathetic communication, counseling, spiritual care, and symptom relief.

Exit Wound

The wound where a projectile leaves the body. Its size and shape vary with the projectile, tissue, clothing, and bone, so appearance alone cannot prove the direction or identify every injury; complete examination is required.

Exocervix

The part of the cervix that projects into the vagina and is covered mainly by flat squamous cells. It is examined during pelvic examination and cervical screening.

Exocrine

Relating to glands that release substances through ducts onto a body surface or into a cavity. Examples include sweat, salivary, tear, and digestive glands.

Exocrine Gland

A specialized glandular organ or cluster of epithelial secretory cells that discharges its non-hormonal secretions into an anatomical duct or directly onto an internal or external epithelial surface (in contrast to endocrine glands, which secrete hormones directly into the bloodstream without ducts). Classified morphologically by duct branching (simple vs compound) and secretory unit architecture (tubular, acinar/alveolar, or tubuloacinar). Classified physiologically by mechanism of secretion: merocrine (eccrine) secretion (secretory products released via exocytosis from membrane-bound vesicles without cell loss, as in salivary glands, eccrine sweat glands, and pancreatic acini); apocrine secretion (secretory products released along with the apical portion of the secretory cell cytoplasm, as in apocrine sweat glands and lactating mammary glands); and holocrine secretion (the entire secretory cell disintegrates and is shed to release its contents, as in cutaneous sebaceous glands).

Alternate Names:
Exocrine Glands

Exocrine Glands

Plural form; see *Exocrine Gland*.

Exocrine Pancreas

The part of the pancreas that releases digestive enzymes and bicarbonate into the small intestine. These secretions help break down fats, proteins, and carbohydrates and neutralize stomach acid.

Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency

Failure of the pancreas to release enough digestive enzymes, causing poor digestion and absorption. It may lead to greasy stools, bloating, diarrhea, weight loss, and vitamin deficiency.

Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency EPI

Alternate index label; see *Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency*.

Alternate Names:
EPI; Pancreatic Exocrine Insufficiency

Exocytosis

The process by which a cell releases substances outside itself. Small sacs inside the cell join its outer membrane and release hormones, nerve signals, digestive enzymes, or other proteins.

Exogenous

Coming from outside the body rather than being produced within it. An exogenous substance may be a medicine, hormone, nutrient, toxin, infection, or other externally introduced material.

Exogenous Cushing Syndrome

A condition caused by prolonged or excessive corticosteroid treatment, producing effects similar to too much natural cortisol. Features may include weight gain, easy bruising, high blood pressure, diabetes, weakness, and bone loss.

Exomphalos

A birth defect in which abdominal organs protrude through the belly button into the base of the umbilical cord and are covered by a membrane. Newborns need protection of the sac and specialist surgical care.

Exon

A segment of a gene that remains in the mature messenger RNA after unused sections are removed. It may contain instructions for making part of a protein or, in some genes, help regulate gene activity.

Exopeptidase

An enzyme that removes amino acids from the end of a protein. Digestive exopeptidases help break dietary proteins into smaller units that the intestine can absorb.

Exophiala

A group of darkly pigmented environmental fungi that can rarely cause skin, lung, eye, or widespread infection. Disease is more likely in people with weakened immunity or implanted medical devices.

Exophthalmic Goitre

An enlarged thyroid associated with Graves disease, in which immune stimulation causes excess thyroid hormone. Graves disease may also cause eye dryness, pain, swelling, or bulging.

Exophthalmos

The abnormal forward protrusion or displacement of one or both eyeballs from the orbit, most frequently caused by Graves disease (thyroid eye disease), orbital tumors, or inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Bulging Eyes; Proptosis; Ocular Proptosis

Exosomes

Very small membrane-covered particles released by cells that carry proteins, fats, and genetic material to other cells. They help cells communicate and are being studied for diagnosis and drug delivery, but many medical uses remain experimental.

Exostosis

A benign growth of bone. It may be harmless, but location can cause pain, pressure, restricted movement, or blockage; repeated cold-water exposure can produce bony growths in the ear canal.

Exotoxins

Poisonous proteins released by some bacteria that damage particular cells or disrupt body functions. They cause diseases such as botulism, tetanus, diphtheria, or cholera, some of which can progress rapidly.

Exotropia

A type of strabismus in which one or both eyes turn outward, away from the nose. It may be intermittent or constant and can occur at any age. It can impair binocular vision or depth perception; in children, persistent misalignment may interfere with visual development. Treatment depends on the cause and may include glasses or surgery.

Expanded Rubella Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Congenital Rubella Syndrome*.

Expectant Treatment

Careful observation with regular review instead of immediate medicine or surgery when immediate intervention is not necessary. It includes clear follow-up and warning signs because treatment may be needed if symptoms worsen or tests change.

Expectorants

Medicines intended to loosen or increase airway mucus so it can be coughed up more easily. Benefits vary, and fluids, humidification, and treatment of the underlying illness may be more important than an expectorant.

Expectoration

Coughing up and bringing mucus or phlegm out of the respiratory tract. Changes in amount, color, smell, blood, fever, or breathlessness may indicate infection or another lung problem.

Experience

A person's direct knowledge, perception, or emotional response to an event. In healthcare, patient experience includes how care is accessed, communicated, coordinated, and received.

Alternate Names:

Subjective Experience; Patient-Reported Experience

Expiration

Movement of air out of the lungs, usually caused by relaxation of the breathing muscles and natural recoil of the lungs. During forceful breathing, abdominal and chest muscles actively push air out.

Expiratory Grunting

A grunting sound made during breathing out, caused by partially closing the voice box. It can briefly help keep small air spaces open but, especially in a baby or child, often signals respiratory distress.

Expiratory Reserve Volume

The maximum additional volume of air that can be actively and forcefully exhaled from the lungs at the end of a normal, quiet tidal expiration, normally measuring approximately 1.0 to 1.2 liters in healthy adults.

Alternate Names:
ERV

Explant

To remove an implanted device, prosthesis, or tissue. The term can also mean tissue removed from an organism and maintained in laboratory culture for study.

Explantation

Surgical removal of an implanted device or prosthesis. It may be needed because of infection, malfunction, migration, breakage, tissue injury, intolerance, or completion of temporary treatment.

Exploratory Laparotomy

Open surgery to enter the abdomen and directly find or treat a serious problem such as bleeding, perforation, blocked bowel, or loss of blood flow when less-invasive tests or treatment are insufficient.

Exploratory Operation

Surgery performed to inspect an area directly when scans, tests, or less-invasive procedures cannot establish the cause or extent of disease. Tissue may be sampled and treatment may be performed during the operation.

Exposure

Contact with a physical, chemical, biological, or psychological agent. Health risk depends on what the agent is, how much contact occurred, how it entered the body, and how long exposure lasted.

Exposure Route

The way a substance enters the body, such as by breathing, swallowing, skin contact, injection, or the eyes. The route affects how quickly and how much of the substance is absorbed and how toxic it may be.

Expression

In genetics, the process by which a gene's information is used to make RNA or protein. In clinical examination, expression can also mean the outward display of emotion or symptoms; altered gene activity can contribute to disease.

Expression Hopping

A shift from one form of addictive behavior to another, such as replacing substance use with compulsive gambling. The underlying loss of control and harm may persist even when the specific behavior changes.

Expressivity

The degree to which a genetic variant's effects appear in a person. Variable expressivity means that people with the same variant may have different features or different severity of the associated condition.

Exsanguinate

To lose or remove a life-threatening amount of blood. It can refer to bleeding from an injury or deliberate removal of blood from a body or body part. Severe blood loss can cause hemorrhagic shock and death. The related noun is exsanguination.

Exsanguination

Life-threatening loss of blood from severe internal or external bleeding. It can rapidly cause shock, organ failure, and death; immediate pressure or bleeding control, emergency care, and blood replacement may be needed.

Exserohilum

A group of darkly pigmented molds that can rarely cause sinus, eye, skin, or invasive infection. Serious disease is more likely in people with weakened immunity and requires specialist testing and treatment.

Extend

To straighten a joint or increase the angle between two bones. For example, extending the elbow moves the forearm away from the upper arm toward a straight position.

Alternate Names:
Extension

Extension

Movement that straightens a joint or increases the angle between bones, such as straightening the knee or elbow. Excessive or forced extension can strain or tear muscles, tendons, ligaments, cartilage, or the joint.

Extensively Drug-Resistant Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis caused by bacteria resistant to several key medicines, including isoniazid, rifampin, a fluoroquinolone, and at least one other important medicine. It is difficult to treat and requires specialist, susceptibility-guided therapy.

Alternate Names:
XDR-TB; XDR Tuberculosis

Extensor

A muscle or other structure that straightens a joint or increases the angle between bones. Extensor muscles commonly act opposite flexor muscles and help position limbs and fingers.

Extensor Digitorum

A forearm muscle whose tendons straighten the fingers and help extend the wrist. Overuse near its origin can contribute to outer-elbow pain commonly called tennis elbow.

Extensor Tendinitis

Irritation or inflammation of a tendon that straightens a joint in the foot or toes. It can cause pain or tenderness over the top of the foot or ankle, especially with repeated movement.

Extensor Plantar Response

An abnormal neurological reflex in which firm tactile stroking of the lateral plantar border of the foot produces slow extension (dorsiflexion) of the great toe accompanied by fanning of the other toes, indicating corticospinal (pyramidal) tract impairment.

Alternate Names:
Positive Babinski Sign; Babinski Reflex

Extent

The size, severity, range, or spread of a disease, injury, symptom, or treatment effect. Describing extent helps determine prognosis, further testing, and treatment.

External

Relating to the outside of a structure or body, or situated farther from the center of an organ or cavity. It contrasts with internal.

External Auditory Canal

The passage from the outer ear to the eardrum. It is lined with skin, hair, and wax-producing glands that help protect the ear, but it can become blocked, irritated, or infected.

External Auditory Canal Exostosis

Benign bony growths that narrow the ear canal, often after repeated exposure to cold water. They may trap water or earwax and cause blockage, infection, or reduced hearing. Also called surfer's ear.

External Beam Partial Breast Irradiation

An accelerated conformal radiation therapy technique delivered via external beam linac that targets

exclusively the lumpectomy cavity margin following breast-conserving surgery, sparing the remainder of the ipsilateral breast tissue in selected early-stage breast cancer patients.

Alternate Names:
EB-APBI; Accelerated Partial Breast Irradiation; Targeted Breast Radiotherapy

External Beam Radiation Therapy

Cancer treatment delivered from a machine outside the body to a carefully planned area. It can damage cancer cells while limiting nearby tissue exposure; fatigue, skin changes, and organ-specific effects may occur.

External Capsule

A thin bundle of nerve fibers in the brain near the basal ganglia. It carries signals between the cerebral cortex and deeper brain regions involved in movement, attention, and other functions.

External Carotid Artery

A major branch of the neck artery that supplies blood to much of the face, scalp, neck, and parts of the brain coverings through several branches.

External Cephalic Version

A procedure in which a clinician applies gentle pressure through the maternal abdomen to turn a fetus from a breech or transverse presentation into a head-down (cephalic) position for vaginal delivery. It is typically performed near term with continuous ultrasound and fetal heart rate monitoring.

Alternate Names:
ECV; Cephalic version.

External Ear

The visible part of the ear and the ear canal leading to the eardrum. It collects sound, directs it inward, and helps protect the middle and inner ear.

External Fixation

Stabilization of a broken bone or injured limb with pins or wires connected to a frame outside the body. It may be temporary or definitive, especially when swelling, wounds, or contamination prevent internal fixation.

External Iliac Artery

A major artery carrying blood from the pelvis toward the leg. It becomes the femoral artery below the groin and gives branches to the lower abdominal wall and pelvic region.

External Iliac Vein

A continuation of the femoral vein above the inguinal ligament that joins the internal iliac vein to form the common iliac vein.

External Incontinence Devices

Products worn or placed outside the body to collect urine or stool or protect clothing from leakage. Examples include urinary sheaths, absorbent products, and fecal collection systems; skin care and correct fitting help prevent injury.

External Jugular Vein

A visible vein running along the side of the neck that drains blood from the scalp and face toward the chest. Its fullness can provide clues about pressure in the right side of the heart.

External Nose

The visible nose formed by bone, cartilage, skin, and soft tissue. It shapes the nasal passages, helps warm and filter inhaled air, supports smell, and contributes to facial structure.

External Oblique Muscle

The broad, superficial muscle on each side of the abdomen. It compresses abdominal contents and helps bend and rotate the trunk; its lower border contributes to the groin ligament and canal.

External Otitis

Inflammation or infection of the ear canal outside the eardrum, often called swimmer's ear. Moisture, scratching, or skin disease may contribute, causing pain, itching, discharge, swelling, or reduced hearing.

Alternate Names:
Otitis Externa; Swimmer's Ear

External Resorption

Loss of tooth root or other tooth structure caused by a process starting outside the tooth. Injury, pressure, inflammation, or replacement by bone may contribute; treatment depends on location and severity.

External Ventricular Drain

A temporary tube placed through the skull into a fluid-filled space in the brain. It measures pressure and drains excess cerebrospinal fluid or blood, for example in some cases of hydrocephalus, bleeding, or serious brain injury.

Alternate Names:
EVD

Extinction

In learning, the fading of a learned response when reinforcement stops. In neurology, it can mean failing to notice one side of the body or space when both sides are stimulated, suggesting an attention disorder.

Extirpation

Complete surgical removal of a tissue, organ, growth, or foreign body. The term describes the extent of removal rather than a particular disease or surgical technique.

Extraamniotic

Located outside the amniotic sac surrounding a fetus. The term may describe a procedure, device, or fluid placed between the amnion and nearby tissues during pregnancy care.

Extracapsular Cataract Surgery

Cataract surgery that removes the cloudy lens while leaving most of its surrounding capsule in place. An artificial lens is usually inserted into the remaining capsule to restore focusing ability.

Extracellular

Located outside cells. Extracellular fluid, proteins, ions, and signals surround cells and help provide nutrients, remove waste, support tissues, and coordinate cell activity.

Extracellular Exosome

A tiny membrane-covered vesicle released by a cell that can carry proteins, fats, and genetic material to other cells. Exosomes help cells communicate and are being studied as disease markers and treatment vehicles.

Extracellular Fluid

Fluid outside cells, including blood plasma and the fluid between cells. It carries nutrients, hormones, and waste and is regulated mainly by the kidneys, circulation, and hormones.

Extracellular Matrix

A network of proteins and other substances outside cells that supports tissues and helps cells attach, communicate, grow, and repair injury. Its composition differs among bone, skin, muscle, and other organs.

Extracellular Pathogens

Microorganisms that live and multiply outside human cells. Examples include Streptococcus, Staphylococcus, and some Escherichia coli. They can damage tissues directly or through toxins, and the immune system usually fights them with antibodies and other defenses.

Extracellular Region

The area outside cells. It contains fluid, minerals, proteins, and signals that support tissues and influence how nearby cells grow, move, and function.

Extracellular Space

The fluid- and matrix-filled area outside cells. Nutrients, waste products, hormones, and signaling molecules move through it, and its composition helps control cell survival, movement, and function.

Extracellular Vesicle

A membrane-bound particle released by a cell that transfers molecular cargo between cells and is studied in physiology, disease, biomarkers, and drug delivery.

Extracellular Volume Fraction

A cardiac MRI measure estimating the proportion of heart muscle tissue occupied by extracellular space. It is calculated from pre- and post-contrast T1 measurements and hematocrit; an increased value can reflect diffuse fibrosis or infiltrative disease, including cardiac amyloidosis.

Extracorporeal

Occurring or performed outside the body; extracorporeal circulation and hemodialysis route blood through an external machine.

Extracorporeal Circulation

Movement of a person's blood through equipment outside the body and back again. Heart-lung machines, dialysis, and some life-support systems use it to add oxygen, remove waste, or support circulation; bleeding, clotting, infection, and organ injury are possible.

Extracorporeal Membrane Oxygenation

A temporary life-support treatment in which blood passes through a machine that adds oxygen and removes carbon dioxide, then returns to the body. It may support the lungs, or both the heart and lungs, during severe illness. Risks include bleeding, blood clots, infection, and damage to blood cells or nearby blood vessels.

Alternate Names:
ECMO; Extracorporeal Life Support; ECLS

Extracorporeal Shock Wave Lithotripsy

A treatment that uses focused shock waves from outside the body to break kidney or ureter stones into smaller pieces that can pass in urine. Bruising, bleeding, pain, blockage, or incomplete stone removal can occur.

Extracranial

Located or occurring outside the skull or cranial cavity. For example, extracranial arteries supply the scalp and face, while extracranial injury affects tissues outside the skull and brain.

Extracranial Hematoma

A collection of blood outside the skull or cranial cavity, usually caused by bleeding into soft tissues after injury.

Extract

A concentrated preparation made by separating active substances from a plant, herb, food, or other source. Strength, purity, interactions, and safety vary widely, especially in unregulated supplements.

Alternate Names:
Botanical Extract; Pharmacological Extract

Extraction

Removal of a tooth, tissue, foreign object, or other material from the body using a procedure. The method and risks depend on what is removed, where it is located, and the person's health.

Extra-Dural

Located outside the dura mater, the tough protective membrane around the brain and spinal cord. The term may describe a space, collection of blood, injection, or other structure outside this membrane.

Extra-Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor

A tumor with features of a gastrointestinal stromal tumor that begins outside the digestive tract, often in abdominal supporting tissues. Diagnosis uses imaging, tissue examination, and molecular tests to guide cancer treatment.

Extragonadal Germ Cell Tumors

Germ-cell tumors arising outside the ovaries or testes, commonly in the mediastinum, retroperitoneum, or central nervous system. They may be seminomatous or nonseminomatous and are evaluated with imaging, tumor markers, pathology, and assessment for a gonadal primary.

Extrahepatic Biliary Atresia

Alternate name; see *Biliary Atresia*.

Extrahepatic Cholestasis

Reduced or blocked bile flow in the ducts outside the liver. Gallstones, scarring, inflammation, or a tumor may cause yellow skin, dark urine, pale stools, itching, pain, or infection.

Extramammary Paget Disease

A rare skin cancer usually affecting the vulva, anus, scrotum, or nearby skin. It often appears as a persistent itchy, sore, red, or scaly patch and requires biopsy to confirm diagnosis and assess for related cancer.

Extramammary Paget's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Extramammary Paget Disease*.

Extramedullary Hematopoiesis

Blood-cell production outside the bone marrow, most often in the liver or spleen. It is normal during fetal development but, after birth, usually occurs when bone-marrow production is inadequate, as in myelofibrosis or severe chronic anemia such as thalassemia.

Alternate Names:
EMH; Extramedullary Blood Formation

Extranodal

Located outside the lymph nodes. An extranodal disease or lymphoma affects an organ or other tissue, such as the stomach, skin, lung, bone, or brain.

Extranodal Marginal Zone Lymphoma

A usually slow-growing cancer of B lymphocytes arising in tissues such as the stomach, salivary glands, thyroid, lungs, or eye. Symptoms depend on the organ involved and treatment may include observation, infection treatment, or cancer therapy.

Alternate Names:
MALT Lymphoma Mucosa-Associated Lymphoid Tissue Lymphoma

Extranodal Natural Killer T-Cell Lymphoma

An aggressive lymphoma arising from immune cells, often affecting the nose and upper throat. It is strongly associated with Epstein-Barr virus and may cause blockage, bleeding, swelling, fever, or tissue destruction.

Extraocular

Outside the eyeball or involving the muscles, nerves, and tissues around it. Extraocular structures move the eye, protect it, support vision, and connect it with the brain and face.

Extraocular Muscle

One of the muscles outside the eyeball that moves the eye in different directions. Weakness or nerve injury can cause double vision, eye misalignment, or difficulty looking in a particular direction.

Extraocular Muscle Function Testing

Examination of eye movements to assess the muscles and nerves that move the eyes. The person follows targets in different directions; abnormal movement can indicate muscle, nerve, brain, or eye-socket disease.

Extraocular Muscles

Plural form; see *Extraocular Muscle*.

Extrapulmonary Manifestation Of Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis affecting tissues outside the lungs, such as lymph nodes, bones, kidneys, the brain coverings, abdomen, or reproductive organs. Symptoms vary by site and treatment requires multiple antibiotics.

Extrapyramidal Disorder

A disorder of brain circuits that regulate movement, posture, and muscle tone. It may cause stiffness, slowness, tremor, abnormal movements, or restlessness and can result from disease or medicines.

Extrapyramidal Symptoms

Movement problems caused by medicines or dis-

eases affecting movement circuits. They include stiffness, tremor, slowed movement, restlessness, sudden spasms, or involuntary movements, commonly after dopamine-blocking medicines.

Extrapyramidal System

Interconnected brain structures and pathways, including the basal ganglia, that help control automatic movement, posture, muscle tone, and coordination. Damage or medicine effects can produce abnormal movements.

Extrapyramidal Tracts

Nerve pathways outside the main voluntary movement tract that influence posture, muscle tone, automatic movements, and coordination. Disturbance can cause stiffness, tremor, slowness, or involuntary movements.

Extraskeletal Chondroma

A benign cartilage-forming lump arising in soft tissue rather than from bone, often in the hands or feet. It may calcify, cause pain or pressure, and sometimes needs removal to confirm the diagnosis.

Extraskeletal Mesenchymal Chondrosarcoma

A rare aggressive cancer of soft tissue that contains malignant cartilage. It may arise outside bone and requires specialist biopsy, staging, and combined cancer treatment.

Extraskeletal Osteosarcoma

A rare aggressive cancer that produces bone-like material in soft tissue rather than beginning inside bone. It usually affects adults and requires imaging, biopsy, staging, and specialist treatment.

Extrasystole

A premature heartbeat caused by an ectopic electrical impulse arising in the atria, atrioventricular junction, or ventricles. Premature atrial contractions and premature ventricular contractions are common types; the term does not refer only to ventricular beats.

Extrauterine Pregnancy

A pregnancy implanted outside the normal uterine cavity, most often in a fallopian tube. It can rupture and cause life-threatening internal bleeding; one-sided pain, fainting, or bleeding may occur.

Extravasation

Leakage of blood, medicine, urine, or another body fluid from a vessel or duct into nearby tissues. It can cause swelling, pain, inflammation, infection, or tissue death; treatment depends on the substance, location, and severity.

Extravascular Hemolysis

The early removal and breakdown of red blood cells mainly in the spleen and liver. It can cause anemia, yellowing of the skin or eyes, and an enlarged spleen.

Alternate Names:
Reticuloendothelial Hemolysis; Splenic Erythrocyte Clearance

Extraventricular Drain

Alternate name; see *External Ventricular Drain*.

Extremities

The arms and legs, including their bones, joints, muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and skin. Problems in an extremity may affect movement, sensation, circulation, or function.

Extremity

A limb of the body. The upper extremity includes the shoulder, arm, forearm, wrist, and hand; the lower extremity includes the hip, thigh, leg, ankle, and foot.

Extremity Angiography

Imaging of blood vessels in an arm or leg, usually after contrast is introduced. It can show narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, abnormal connections, or injury and may sometimes be combined with treatment.

Extremity Hardware Removal

Surgical extraction of orthopedic implants such as

plates, screws, intramedullary rods, or wires from an arm or leg. Typically indicated for persistent localized pain, implant infection, mechanical irritation, soft-tissue impingement, nonunion, or planned subsequent procedures.

Alternate Names:
Orthopedic Hardware Removal; Implant Removal; Plate and Screw Removal

Extremity X-Ray

An X-ray image of an arm or leg used to look for fractures, joint alignment problems, arthritis, infection, tumors, foreign objects, or other bone abnormalities.

Extrinsic

Coming from outside a structure, organ, or person. An extrinsic cause may be an external injury, medicine, infection, toxin, environmental exposure, or other outside influence.

Extrinsic Allergic Alveolitis

An immune-mediated lung disease caused by repeated inhalation of organic dusts, molds, bird proteins, or other environmental substances. It can cause cough, breathlessness, fever, and, with ongoing exposure, permanent lung scarring.

Alternate Names:
Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis

Extrinsic Factor

An influence from outside a person, tissue, or body process. Examples include medicines, infections, toxins, temperature, nutrition, stress, and environmental exposure; effects depend on the type and amount.

Extrinsic Ureteral Obstruction

Blockage of a ureter caused by pressure from outside the ureter, such as a tumor, scar tissue, enlarged lymph nodes, blood-vessel abnormality, or nearby inflammation. It can reduce urine drainage and cause kidney swelling or loss of kidney function.

Alternate Names:
Extrinsic Ureteral Compression; Secondary Ureteral Obstruction

Extubate

To remove a breathing tube after a person can breathe adequately, protect the airway, clear secretions, and maintain safe oxygen levels without the ventilator.

Extubation

Removal of a breathing tube from the windpipe after a person can breathe independently, keep the airway open, clear secretions, and maintain adequate oxygen and carbon-dioxide levels.

Extubation Criteria

Findings used to judge whether a person can safely have a breathing tube removed. They include adequate breathing and oxygenation, stable circulation, alertness, airway protection, effective cough, and recovery from muscle-paralyzing medicines.

Exudate

Protein-rich fluid that leaks from inflamed or injured blood vessels into tissues or a body cavity. Its presence usually indicates inflammation, infection, or tissue injury rather than pressure alone.

Exudative Pleural Effusion

A protein-rich collection of fluid between the lung and chest wall caused by local inflammation or injury. Pneumonia, cancer, tuberculosis, and blood clots are possible causes; testing the fluid helps guide treatment.

Eye

The organ that detects light and forms vision. It includes the cornea, lens, iris, retina, optic nerve, and supporting tissues within the eye socket; disease can affect sight, movement, comfort, or appearance.

Eye Allergies

An allergic reaction affecting the eyes and often the inner eyelids. It usually causes itching, redness, watering, burning, or swollen eyelids and is commonly called allergic conjunctivitis.

Alternate Names:
Eye Allergy Ocular Allergy

Eye And Orbit Ultrasound

An ultrasound scan of the eye and surrounding socket. It can assess the retina, optic nerve, eye muscles, masses, bleeding, or other structures when the view through the front of the eye is obscured.

Eyeball

The roughly spherical organ of vision containing the cornea, sclera, iris, lens, retina, internal fluids, and other tissues. It focuses light onto the retina, which sends visual signals through the optic nerve.

Alternate Names:
Globe

Eye Bank

An organization that recovers, evaluates, stores, and distributes donated corneas or other eye tissue for transplantation, research, or education. Donor screening and tissue testing help protect recipients.

Eye Bleed

Bleeding on, inside, or around the eye. A bright-red painless patch on the white of the eye is often superficial, but bleeding inside the eye, pain, injury, or vision change requires prompt assessment.

Eyebrow

A strip of hair above the eye socket that helps divert sweat, water, and particles away from the eye and contributes to facial expression.

Eye Cancer

A cancer that begins in the eyelid, surface of the eye, uvea, retina, or tissues around the eye. Warning signs can include a growing or changing spot, persistent redness, vision changes, eye pain, bulging, or a new pupil abnormality; diagnosis usually requires specialist examination and imaging or biopsy.

Eye Color

The visible color of the iris, determined mainly by pigment and light scattering. A new, one-sided, uneven, or painful color change may indicate injury, inflammation, medicine effects, or another eye disorder.

Eye Development

Formation and maturation of the eyes, optic nerves, and visual pathways before and after birth. Disruption can cause structural abnormalities, reduced vision, misalignment, or delayed development of visual skills.

Eye Disease

Any disorder affecting the eye or visual pathways, including refractive errors, cataract, glaucoma, retinal disease, infection, inflammation, and tumors. Symptoms such as sudden vision loss, severe pain, flashes, or a curtain-like shadow can occur with sight-threatening disease.

Eye Disorder

Any pathological, functional, inflammatory, or structural abnormality affecting the eye, its ocular adnexa (eyelids, lacrimal apparatus, conjunctiva, orbit), extraocular muscles, or visual neural pathways (optic nerve, optic chiasm, optic radiations, visual cortex). Manifests with visual impairment (blurred vision, metamorphopsia, scotomas, visual field defects, blindness), ocular pain, redness (ciliary or conjunctival injection), photophobia, diplopia, or discharge. Encompasses major global categories: refractive errors (myopia, hyperopia, astigmatism, presbyopia); lens opacification (cataracts, the leading cause of reversible blindness worldwide); optic neuropathies characterized by progressive retinal ganglion cell axon loss (glaucoma, open-angle and angle-closure); retinal vascular and degenerative diseases (age-related macular degeneration, diabetic retinopathy, retinal vein/artery occlusion, retinal detachment); infectious/inflammatory conditions (keratitis, uveitis, endophthalmitis); and neuro-ophthalmic disorders (optic neuritis, papilledema).

Alternate Names:
Eye Disorders; Ophthalmic Disorder; Ocular Disease

Eye Disorders

Plural form; see *Eye Disorder*.

Eye Drops

Liquid medicines, lubricants, or diagnostic preparations placed on the eye surface. They may re-

lieve dryness or treat disease; contaminated bottles, shared drops, or incorrect use can cause injury or infection.

Eye Emergencies

Conditions requiring immediate assessment include sudden vision loss, chemical exposure, penetrating injury, severe pain, new neurologic symptoms, or rapidly spreading infection. Pressure on an injured eye can worsen damage.

Eye Floaters

Alternate name; see *Floaters*.

Eyeglass

A lens mounted in a frame to correct focusing problems such as nearsightedness, farsightedness, astigmatism, or presbyopia. The prescription is selected after measuring vision and the eyes.

Eye Health

Maintaining vision and preventing avoidable eye disease through appropriate examinations, injury and ultraviolet protection, control of diabetes and blood pressure, safe contact-lens care, and prompt attention to new symptoms.

Eye Hemorrhage

Bleeding on, inside, or around the eye. A small surface bleed may be painless, while bleeding in the retina, vitreous, or eye socket can impair vision or cause pressure.

Eye Infection

Infection of the eyelid, conjunctiva, cornea, internal eye, or surrounding tissues caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites. Pain, light sensitivity, reduced vision, or swelling around the eye needs prompt care.

Eye Injury

Damage to the eye or nearby tissues from blunt or penetrating trauma, chemicals, foreign objects, radiation, or heat. Vision change, severe pain, bleeding, or an embedded object may indicate serious injury.

Eye Irritation

Burning, itching, redness, or watering caused by dryness, allergy, smoke, chemicals, infection, or a foreign particle. Chemical exposure can damage the eye and may cause lasting vision loss.

Eyelash

One of the short, curved protective hairs growing in rows along the edges of the upper and lower eyelids. Eyelashes protect the eyes by sweeping away dust, sweat, and debris, and their sensitive root nerves trigger an involuntary blinking reflex when touched by foreign particles.

Alternate Names:
Eyelashes; Cilia (Eyelashes)

Eyelashes

Plural form; see *Eyelash*.

Eyelid

A movable, specialized bi-lamellar musculo-fibromucous fold that covers and protects the anterior surface of the globe (eyeball). Structurally organized into an anterior lamella (composed of thin, delicate skin without subcutaneous adipose tissue and the concentric striated fibers of the orbicularis oculi muscle, innervated by the facial nerve [CN VII] and responsible for eyelid closure) and a posterior lamella (composed of the dense fibrous tarsal plate, which provides structural rigidity, modified sebaceous meibomian glands that secrete the lipid tear film layer, and the palpebral conjunctiva). Upper eyelid elevation is mediated by the levator palpebrae superioris muscle (innervated by the oculomotor nerve [CN III]) and the superior tarsal (Müller) muscle (innervated by sympathetics). The eyelids protect the ocular surface from mechanical trauma and light, maintain corneal hydration by sweeping the tear film across the ocular surface during blinking, and facilitate tear drainage into the lacrimal puncta. Clinical conditions include ptosis (drooping upper lid from CN III palsy, Horner syndrome, or aponeurotic dehiscence), ectropion (outward eversion of the lid margin), entropion (inward inversion), blepharitis, chalazion, and hordeolum.

Alternate Names:

Eyelids; Palpebra

Eyelid Bump

A localized eyelid swelling, often a painful infected gland called a stye or a firmer blocked oil gland called a chalazion. Warm compresses may help; persistent, recurrent, or vision-affecting bumps need examination.

Eyelid Cancer

Cancer arising in the skin or other tissues of the eyelid, most commonly basal cell carcinoma. A persistent or changing lump, sore, bleeding area, loss of eyelashes, or eyelid distortion needs ophthalmic or dermatologic evaluation.

Eyelid Coloboma

A birth defect causing a notch or missing section of the eyelid. It may leave the eye exposed, impair closure, and occur with other eye or facial abnormalities requiring specialist assessment.

Eyelid Disorder

A disease or structural problem of the eyelid, such as infection, inflammation, a blocked gland, malposition, weakness, or tumor. It may cause pain, swelling, poor eye protection, irritation, or visual problems.

Eyelid Drooping

Alternate name; see *Ptosis*.

Eyelid Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Blepharitis*.

Eyelid Lift

Alternate name; see *Blepharoplasty*.

Eyelid Neoplasm

A benign, precancerous, or cancerous growth of the eyelid. A persistent, enlarging, changing, bleeding, crusted, or ulcerated lesion needs examination by an eye or skin specialist.

Eyelid Problems

Disorders affecting eyelid skin, glands, muscles, nerves, position, or movement, including blepharitis, styes, chalazia, ptosis, entropion, ectropion, and tumors. Pain, vision change, severe swelling, or sudden onset requires prompt assessment.

Eyelids

Plural form; see *Eyelid*.

Eyelid Swelling

Puffiness of one or both eyelids caused by allergy, infection, inflammation, injury, a blocked gland, or fluid accumulation. Fever, severe pain, impaired eye movement, bulging eye, or vision change may indicate an emergency.

Eyelid Twitch

Alternate name; see *Eye Twitching*.

Eye Melanoma

A cancer arising from pigment-producing cells in the eye, most often in the uvea. It may cause blurred vision, flashes, a dark spot, or no symptoms; treatment depends on size, location, spread, and vision potential.

Alternate Names:
Uveal Melanoma; Ocular Melanoma; Choroidal Melanoma

Eye Movement

Coordinated movement of the eyes that directs gaze and keeps images aligned. It depends on the eye muscles, their nerves, and brain control; abnormal movement may cause double vision or imbalance.

Eye Muscle Repair

Treatment to correct a damaged or misaligned eye muscle or its attachment, usually by eye-muscle surgery. It may improve alignment or double vision but does not always restore normal movement and carries surgical risks.

Eye Neoplasm

A benign or malignant growth arising in the eye

or surrounding tissues. Symptoms and treatment depend on the tissue involved, size, location, effect on vision, and whether the growth has spread.

Eye Pain

Pain in or around the eye caused by surface irritation, infection, injury, inflammation, glaucoma, or disease behind the eye. Severe pain with vision loss, light sensitivity, nausea, or trauma can occur with serious eye disease.

Eye Prosthesis

An artificial eye or implant used to restore appearance after an eye is lost or severely damaged. It generally does not restore sight; fitting, cleaning, and periodic specialist care are needed.

Eye Redness

Redness caused by enlarged or inflamed blood vessels on or inside the eye. Irritation and conjunctivitis are common causes, but pain, light sensitivity, discharge, injury, or vision change may indicate serious disease.

Eye Retraction Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Duane Retraction Syndrome*.

Eyesight

Alternate name; see *Vision*.

Eyestrain

Tired, dry, sore, or uncomfortable eyes, sometimes with blurred vision or headache, after prolonged visual effort. Screen use, glare, poor lighting, dry eye, or an uncorrected focusing problem may contribute; rest often helps.

Eye Trauma

Injury ranging from a surface scratch to a penetrating wound or ruptured eyeball. Chemical exposure can cause progressive injury; pressure, rubbing, vision change, or severe pain may worsen or indicate serious damage.

Eye Twitching

Repeated involuntary eyelid or eye-area spasms, commonly linked to fatigue, stress, caffeine, irritation, or eye strain. Persistent spasms, facial weakness, eye closure, or other neurologic symptoms may indicate another condition.

Ezetimibe

An oral medicine that reduces absorption of cholesterol from the intestine. It lowers blood cholesterol alone or with another medicine and may cause diarrhea, abdominal discomfort, or rarely liver or muscle problems.

F

Fab Immunoglobulins

Antibody fragments containing one antigen-binding site, formed by one light chain and part of one heavy chain. Fab fragments bind a specific target but lack the antibody Fc region that mediates many immune functions.

Fabry Disease

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by reduced activity of alpha-galactosidase A because of a disease-causing variant in the *GLA* gene. Globotriaosylceramide and related substances accumulate in cells, especially in blood vessels, the kidneys, heart, nerves, and skin. Features may include burning pain in the hands and feet, reduced sweating, small dark-red skin spots, kidney disease, heart disease, or stroke. The condition is usually X-linked and can affect people of any sex.

Fabry's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Fabry Disease*.

Face

The front part of the head, including the eyes, nose, mouth, cheeks, and jaw. Its muscles produce facial expression, its nerves provide movement and sensation, and its structures support breathing, eating, speech, and vision.

Face and Brow Presentation

Fetal presentations in which the head is extended so the face or forehead leads into the birth canal. Face presentation involves full extension and is assessed by the direction the chin faces; brow presentation involves partial extension and has a different likelihood of vaginal birth.

Facelift

Cosmetic surgery that removes or repositions selected facial and neck skin and deeper tissues to reduce sagging. It does not stop aging and may cause bleeding, infection, nerve injury, scarring, or temporary swelling and numbness.

Alternate Names:
Rhytidectomy

Face Pain

Alternate name; see *Facial Pain*.

Face Powder Poisoning

Illness after swallowing or inhaling face powder or its ingredients. Effects depend on the product and amount and may include coughing, choking, vomiting, drowsiness, or breathing problems.

Face Presentation

A birth position in which the baby's neck is extended so the face, rather than the top of the head, leads through the birth canal. The baby's chin direction helps determine whether vaginal birth is safe.

Facet Joint

A small joint at the back of the spine connecting neighboring vertebrae and guiding movement. Arthritis, injury, or inflammation can cause localized neck or back pain and stiffness.

Facet Joint Syndrome

Back or neck pain thought to come from the small joints linking the bones of the spine. Pain may

worsen with bending backward or twisting, but these symptoms are not specific to the facet joints. The term describes a suspected source of pain rather than one test-confirmed disease.

Facet Joints

Plural form; see *Facet Joint*.

Facet Rhizotomy

A procedure that uses heat or another method to interrupt small nerves carrying pain signals from joints at the back of the spine. It may reduce selected chronic neck or back pain, but relief may be temporary.

Facial Anatomy in Cutaneous Surgery

The layered arrangement of facial skin, fat, muscles, nerves, vessels, glands, and connective tissue that guides safe dermatologic and reconstructive procedures. Knowledge of relaxed skin tension lines and danger zones helps preserve function and appearance.

Facial Asymmetry

A difference in the size, position, movement, or shape of the two sides of the face. It may be present from birth or result from injury, nerve weakness, muscle disease, swelling, or a growth.

Facial Cleft

A birth defect caused by incomplete joining of facial tissues during development. It may affect the lip, nose, mouth, or other facial structures and can interfere with feeding, speech, breathing, hearing, or appearance.

Facial Colliculus

An anatomical elevation on the floor of the fourth ventricle in the dorsal pons, formed by motor fibers of the facial nerve (cranial nerve VII) looping over the underlying abducens nucleus (cranial nerve VI); a lesion produces ipsilateral facial paralysis and lateral gaze palsy.

Facial Edema

Swelling of the face caused by excess fluid in tissues. Allergy, infection, injury, kidney or heart disease, and blocked veins may cause it; sudden lip, tongue, or throat swelling with breathing difficulty is an emergency.

Facial Expression

The visible movement or position of facial muscles that communicates emotion, pain, intention, or other information. Reduced or unequal expression can indicate facial-nerve or muscle dysfunction.

Facial Fractures

Breaks in one or more facial bones, such as the nasal, orbital, cheek, maxillary, or mandibular bones, usually caused by trauma. Pain, swelling, deformity, bleeding, double vision, malocclusion, or airway problems may occur.

Facial Muscle

A muscle that moves the skin of the face for expression and helps with speaking, eating, breathing through the mouth, or closing the eyes. Weakness may result from nerve, muscle, or brain disease.

Facial Neoplasm

A benign or malignant growth arising in facial skin, soft tissue, bone, salivary glands, nerves, or other structures. Symptoms and treatment depend on its tissue of origin, size, location, and spread.

Facial Nerve

The seventh cranial nerve, which controls facial expression and carries taste from part of the tongue. It also contributes to tear and saliva production and helps protect the ear from loud sounds.

Facial Nerve Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of facial muscles caused by dysfunction of the seventh cranial nerve. It may affect eye closure, smiling, taste, tears, or saliva; sudden weakness with arm or speech symptoms may indicate a stroke.

Facial Nerve Palsy From Birth Trauma

One-sided facial weakness in a newborn caused by pressure on the facial nerve during birth. It often improves as the nerve recovers. Weakness can interfere with eye closure or feeding, and other causes of facial weakness should be excluded.

Facial Nerve Problems

Disorders affecting the nerve that controls facial movement and some taste, tear, saliva, and sound-protection functions. Causes include Bell palsy, stroke, infection, injury, or a tumor; sudden weakness may occur with stroke or other acute disease.

Alternate Names:
Facial Nerve Disorder; Facial Nerve Dysfunction

Facial Nucleus

A group of nerve cells in the pons, part of the brainstem, whose fibers form the facial nerve and control facial-expression muscles. Injury can cause weakness of the face and related functions.

Facial Pain

Pain in the face that may arise from teeth, sinuses, jaw joints, nerves, skin, or other tissues. The location and associated symptoms help identify the cause.

Facial Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of facial muscles caused by dysfunction of the facial nerve or its brain pathways. Causes include Bell palsy, stroke, infection, injury, Lyme disease, and tumors; the pattern of weakness and accompanying findings vary with the cause.

Alternate Names:
Facial Paralysis

Facial Paralysis

Partial or complete loss of facial-muscle movement caused by disease or injury of the facial nerve or its brain pathways. Sudden onset, especially with limb weakness or speech trouble, may occur with stroke.

Facial Paresis

Weakness of muscles supplied by the facial nerve, causing reduced facial movement and sometimes poor eye closure, altered taste, or abnormal tearing. The cause may be nerve inflammation, injury, infection, stroke, or a tumor.

Facial Rejuvenation

A broad group of cosmetic treatments intended to reduce visible signs of facial aging or alter facial contours. Methods may include skin resurfacing, injectable treatments, and surgery such as a facelift or blepharoplasty.

Facial Soft Tissue Injuries

Lacerations, abrasions, contusions, punctures, or avulsions involving the skin and underlying soft tissues of the face. Associated injuries can involve facial nerves, ducts, vessels, the eye, and deeper facial structures.

Facial Spasm

Involuntary repeated tightening of facial muscles. It may affect one side around the eye or mouth and can result from nerve irritation, medicines, stress, or another neurologic disorder.

Facial Swelling

Enlargement of part or all of the face caused by infection, allergy, injury, dental or salivary disease, sinus disease, fluid retention, or a growth. Rapid swelling of the mouth or throat with breathing difficulty is an emergency.

Facial Tics

Sudden, repeated, involuntary facial movements or sounds, such as blinking, grimacing, or nose wrinkling. They may increase with stress and occur in tic disorders; persistent or disruptive tics can be treated.

Facial Trauma

Injury affecting facial skin, soft tissue, teeth, nerves, blood vessels, eyes, nose, or bones. Associated concerns include airway injury, bleeding, vision loss, brain injury, and structural damage.

Facial Vein

A vein that drains blood from the superficial face toward the internal jugular vein. Connections with deeper veins mean facial infections can rarely spread toward the eye socket or brain.

Facies

A distinctive pattern of facial features associated with a disease or physiologic state. Examples include the rounded facial appearance of Cushing syndrome and reduced facial expression in Parkinson disease. A facies may suggest a diagnosis but cannot confirm it by itself.

Facies Hippocratica

A historical term for a gaunt, sunken facial appearance described in severe illness or near death. It is nonspecific and does not identify a particular disease.

Alternate Names:
Hippocratic Facies; Hippocratic Face

Facilitated Diffusion

Movement of a substance across a cell membrane through a channel or carrier protein, from higher to lower concentration. The process does not directly use cellular energy and helps move substances that cannot cross the membrane unaided.

Facio-Scapulo-Humeral Dystrophy

Alternate name; see *Facioscapulohumeral Muscular Dystrophy*.

Facioscapulohumeral Dystrophy

Alternate name; see *Facioscapulohumeral Muscular Dystrophy*.

Facioscapulohumeral Muscular Dystrophy

An inherited disorder causing progressive, often uneven weakness of facial, shoulder-blade, and upper-arm muscles. Symptoms may begin in adolescence or adulthood and can later involve the trunk, hips, or legs.

Factitious Disorder

A mental disorder in which a person deliberately falsifies or induces physical or psychological signs or symptoms in themselves and presents as ill, impaired, or injured. The behavior involves identified deception and occurs without an obvious external reward; this distinguishes it from malingering, in which symptom production is motivated by an external incentive.

Alternate Names:
Munchausen Syndrome; Pathomimicry

Factitious Disorder by Proxy

Alternate name; see *Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another*.

Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another

A mental disorder in which a person falsifies or induces physical or psychological symptoms in another person under their care and presents that person as ill or injured, with identified deception and no obvious external reward. The behavior can seriously harm the dependent person and is a form of abuse.

Alternate Names:
Munchausen Syndrome by Proxy; MSBP; Pediatric Symptom Falsification

Factitious Disorders

Alternate name; see *Factitious Disorder*.

Factitious Hyperthyroidism

A state of excessive thyroid hormone in the body caused by ingestion of thyroid hormone or another external source rather than increased thyroid-gland production.

Factor

A substance that contributes to a biological process or clinical result. In hematology, the term usually refers to blood-clotting proteins that work together to stop bleeding.

Factor H Deficiency

A rare inherited or acquired problem in which a protein that keeps part of the immune system under

control is missing or faulty. It can cause repeated infections or inflammation that damages small blood vessels, especially in the kidneys.

Factor I Deficiency

An ambiguous name for two distinct disorders. In blood clotting, factor I is fibrinogen, and its deficiency can cause abnormal bleeding. In immunology, complement factor I deficiency disrupts regulation of the complement system and can increase susceptibility to bacterial infections. The intended disorder should be specified as fibrinogen deficiency or complement factor I deficiency.

Factor II Assay

A blood test measuring factor II activity, which helps assess the clotting pathway and investigate abnormal bleeding, prolonged prothrombin time, or suspected prothrombin deficiency or inhibition.

Factor IX

A vitamin-K-dependent blood-clotting protein that works with factor VIII to form clots. Inherited deficiency causes hemophilia B, leading to prolonged or spontaneous bleeding, especially into joints and muscles.

Factor IX Assay

A blood test measuring factor IX activity, used to diagnose or monitor factor IX deficiency, the cause of hemophilia B, and to guide replacement treatment.

Factor V

A blood-clotting protein that helps generate thrombin and fibrin, the mesh that strengthens a clot. Too little can cause bleeding; an inherited change affecting its regulation can increase venous-clot risk.

Factor V Assay

A blood test measuring how well factor V supports clotting. It helps investigate abnormal bleeding or clotting-test results and diagnose inherited deficiency or an acquired reduction from liver disease or other illness.

Factor V Deficiency

An inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by too little active factor V. It may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or excessive bleeding after injury, dental work, surgery, or childbirth.

Factor VII

A liver-made blood-clotting protein that starts clot formation when tissue is injured. Inherited or acquired deficiency can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, or serious bleeding after injury or procedures.

Factor VII Assay

A blood test measuring factor VII activity. It helps investigate a prolonged prothrombin time and identify inherited deficiency, liver disease, vitamin-K deficiency, or medicine-related reduction.

Factor VII Deficiency

A bleeding disorder caused by too little or poorly functioning factor VII. Bleeding severity varies and may include bruising, nosebleeds, heavy periods, bleeding after surgery, or severe hemorrhage; prothrombin time is usually prolonged.

Factor VIII

A blood-clotting protein that works with factor IX to form a stable clot. Inherited deficiency causes hemophilia A, with prolonged or spontaneous bleeding, often into joints, muscles, or other tissues.

Factor VIII Assay

A blood test measuring factor VIII activity. It helps diagnose or monitor hemophilia A and investigate acquired reductions caused by inhibitors, liver disease, or other conditions.

Factor V Leiden

The most common inherited blood clotting disorder, caused by a genetic mutation that alters a clotting protein called factor V. Because of this mutation, factor V cannot be easily switched off by the body's natural anticoagulant mechanisms, making the blood more prone to forming abnormal clots.

People with this condition have an increased risk of developing deep vein thrombosis (clots in the legs) and pulmonary embolism (clots in the lungs), although many carriers never experience a clot.

Alternate Names:
FVL; Activated Protein C Resistance; APCR

Factor V Leiden Mutation

Alternate name; see *Factor V Leiden*.

Factor X

A blood-clotting protein that helps start the final steps of clot formation. Too little factor X can cause prolonged or unexpected bleeding and is assessed with clotting tests and other blood studies.

Factor X Assay

A blood test measuring factor X activity, a key clotting step shared by two clotting pathways. It helps investigate abnormal bleeding and diagnose or monitor inherited or acquired factor X deficiency.

Factor X Deficiency

A rare inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by too little active factor X. Bleeding severity varies from bruising to serious hemorrhage, and both major clotting-time tests may be prolonged.

Factor XI Deficiency

An inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by reduced factor XI activity. Bleeding is variable and is often noticed after surgery, dental procedures, childbirth, or trauma rather than occurring spontaneously.

Factor XII

A blood-clotting protein that starts one pathway measured by laboratory clotting tests. Factor XII deficiency can greatly prolong the activated partial-thromboplastin time but usually does not cause abnormal bleeding.

Factor XII Assay

A blood test measuring factor XII activity. It may help explain an isolated prolonged activated partial-thromboplastin time, especially when the person has no unusual bleeding.

Factor XII Deficiency

A deficiency of factor XII that can greatly prolong one laboratory clotting test but usually does not cause bleeding. It is often discovered unexpectedly during testing for another reason.

Factor XIII

The clot-stabilizing protein that strengthens the fibrin mesh after a clot forms. Factor XIII deficiency can cause delayed bleeding, poor wound healing, or repeated pregnancy loss despite initially normal routine clotting tests.

Factor XIII Deficiency

A rare inherited or acquired bleeding disorder caused by too little factor XIII, the protein that strengthens a blood clot. Bleeding may start hours after an injury or procedure and can include bleeding from the umbilical cord in newborns, poor wound healing, or bleeding in the brain. Routine clotting tests may be normal.

Alternate Names:
Fibrin-Stabilizing Factor Deficiency; FXIII Deficiency

Facultative Anaerobe

A microorganism that can grow with or without oxygen. It uses oxygen when available but can switch to other energy-producing processes when oxygen is absent; many intestinal bacteria have this ability.

Faecal Fistula

An abnormal connection between the intestine and another organ, the skin, or the body surface that allows stool or intestinal fluid to leak. It can cause infection, dehydration, skin injury, and poor nutrition.

Faecalibacterium

A group of oxygen-sensitive bacteria commonly found in the intestine. They can produce butyrate, a substance that supports the colon lining; their

presence is studied in relation to gut health and inflammation.

Faeces

Alternate spelling; see *Feces*.

Faget Sign

The unusual clinical physical finding of fever accompanied by a paradoxically normal or slow pulse rate (sphygmothermic dissociation / relative bradycardia), classically seen in yellow fever, typhoid fever, Legionnaires' disease, and tularemia.

Alternate Names:
Faget's Sign; Sphygmothermic Dissociation

Fahr Disease

An older name for primary familial brain calcification, an uncommon inherited condition in which calcium deposits build up in brain regions. Some people have no symptoms; others develop movement, thinking, or psychiatric changes. Similar deposits can occur for other reasons, so primary and secondary causes are distinguished.

Fahr's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Fahr Disease*.

Fahr's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Fahr Disease*.

Fahr Syndrome

An older, imprecise name sometimes used for brain calcium deposits from inherited or other causes; see *Fahr Disease*.

Failed Induction Of Labor

Failure of labor to progress after medicines or procedures intended to start it. The decision to continue induction or perform cesarean birth depends on cervical change, contractions, time, the mother's condition, and fetal well-being.

Failed Intubation

Inability to place a breathing tube safely in the windpipe. It is an airway emergency in which oxygen delivery and alternative airway methods are central to management.

Failure To Thrive

Older term for faltering weight, a pattern of slower-than-expected weight gain in a child. See *Faltering Weight*.

Fainting

A brief loss of consciousness and muscle tone caused by temporarily reduced blood flow to the brain, followed by spontaneous recovery. Reflex episodes are common; fainting during exercise, with chest pain, or without warning can occur with serious causes.

Alternate Names:
Syncope; Passing Out

Falciform Ligament

A fold of tissue attaching the liver to the front abdominal wall and diaphragm. It marks the division between the liver's right and left lobes and contains the remnant of a fetal umbilical vein.

Falciparum Malaria

Malaria caused by Plasmodium falciparum parasites transmitted by infected mosquitoes. It can worsen rapidly and cause brain involvement, severe anemia, kidney injury, breathing failure, shock, or death.

Fall

An unplanned movement to the ground or another lower level. Falls may result from poor balance, weakness, vision problems, medicines, dizziness, low blood pressure, or environmental hazards and can cause serious injury.

Fallen Arches

Flattening of the foot's inner arch, also called flat feet. It may be flexible or rigid and may cause no symptoms or lead to foot, ankle, knee, or back discomfort; treatment depends on symptoms and cause.

Alternate Names:
Pes Planus; Flat Feet; Flatfoot; Fallen Foot Arches

Fallen Bladder

A common term for bladder prolapse, in which weakened pelvic-support tissues allow the bladder to bulge into the front wall of the vagina. It may cause pressure, leakage, incomplete emptying, or no symptoms.

Fallopian Tube

One of a pair of narrow, muscular tubes in the female reproductive system connecting each ovary to the uterus. Each month, the tube's delicate finger-like ends sweep up an egg released by the ovary and gently guide it inward. The fallopian tube is the normal site where fertilization takes place when sperm meets the egg, after which the fertilized egg travels into the uterus to implant.

Alternate Names:
Fallopian Tubes; Uterine Tube; Oviduct; Salpinx

Fallopian Tube Cancer

A rare cancer beginning in a fallopian tube. It may cause pelvic pain, a mass, abnormal or watery discharge, or no early symptoms; diagnosis, staging, and treatment resemble those for ovarian cancer.

Fallopian Tube Disorders

Disorders affecting the tubes that transport the ovum, including infection, inflammation, blockage, ectopic pregnancy, hydrosalpinx, torsion, endometriosis, and cancer. They may cause pelvic pain, infertility, abnormal bleeding, or acute abdominal symptoms.

Fallopian-Tube Endometriosis

Endometriosis involving or surrounding a fallopian tube. It may cause pelvic pain, adhesions, or infertility, or be found unexpectedly; treatment depends on symptoms, disease extent, and fertility goals.

Fallopian Tubes

Plural form; see *Fallopian Tube*.

Fallopian Tube Torsion

Twisting of a fallopian tube, sometimes around a cyst or fluid-filled tube, that can cut off blood flow. It may cause sudden severe pelvic pain, nausea, or vomiting.

Fallot's Tetralogy

A birth defect combining four heart abnormalities that reduce blood flow to the lungs and may cause bluish skin, breathing difficulty, poor growth, or fainting. Specialist care and usually surgery are required.

Fall Prevention

Steps to reduce falling, including strength and balance training, medication review, vision and hearing checks, safe footwear, adequate lighting, removal of hazards, and support with walking when needed.

Fall Risk

The likelihood of falling based on factors such as previous falls, balance, walking ability, strength, vision, medicines, dizziness, blood-pressure changes, cognition, and environmental hazards.

Falls

Plural form; see *Fall*.

Fall Screening

A brief assessment of previous falls, balance, walking, strength, medicines, vision, dizziness, cognition, and surroundings to identify fall risk and guide prevention or further evaluation.

False Labor

Contractions that may be uncomfortable but do not progressively open and thin the cervix. They are often irregular and may lessen with rest, hydration, or a change in activity, unlike established labor.

False Negative

A test result that says a condition is absent when it is actually present. It can occur because testing was too early, the sample was inadequate, the condition level was low, or the test was not sensitive enough.

False-Negative Result

A negative result when the tested condition is actu-

ally present. Early testing, an inadequate sample, prior treatment, low levels of the target, technical error, or limited test sensitivity can cause it.

False Passages

Abnormal channels made through tissue during instrumentation, surgery, or injury instead of following the normal body pathway. They can cause bleeding, perforation, infection, or failure to place a tube correctly.

False Positive

A test result that indicates a condition is present when it is not. It may result from cross-reaction, contamination, technical error, or testing in a group where the condition is uncommon.

False-Positive Result

A positive result when the tested condition is actually absent. Cross-reaction, contamination, technical error, limited specificity, or testing in a low-risk population can produce it.

False Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Pseudocyesis*.

False Ribs

The lower ribs that do not attach directly to the breastbone. Their cartilage joins the cartilage above or ends freely, allowing flexibility but leaving them vulnerable to injury in some areas.

Faltering Weight

Slower-than-expected weight gain or a concerning downward change in a child's growth pattern. The 2026 AAP and NASPGHAN guideline uses this term in place of failure to thrive; feeding difficulty, inadequate intake, poor absorption, chronic disease, or other factors may contribute.

Alternate Names:
Failure To Thrive; Growth Faltering

Falx Cerebelli

A small, triangular crescent-shaped fold of dura mater situated in the posterior cranial fossa inferior to the tentorium cerebelli, projecting vertically forward between the right and left cerebellar hemispheres.

Falx Cerebri

A large, sickle-shaped vertical fold of dura mater that dips vertically into the longitudinal cerebral fissure between the right and left cerebral hemispheres, attaching anteriorly to the crista galli and frontal crest and posteriorly to the tentorium cerebelli and internal occipital protuberance.

Famciclovir

An antiviral medicine that changes into penciclovir in the body and limits multiplication of herpes viruses. It can treat selected shingles, cold-sore, or genital-herpes episodes but does not remove the virus permanently.

Familial

Occurring more often within a family because of shared genes, environment, behaviors, or a combination. Familial does not necessarily mean that one specific gene causes the condition.

Familial Adenomatous Polyposis

A rare, inherited genetic condition characterized by the growth of hundreds to thousands of noncancerous polyps throughout the colon and rectum, usually beginning in the teenage years. Caused by a mutation in the extitAPC gene, this condition carries a near 100% lifetime risk of developing colorectal cancer if the colon is not removed, and affected individuals require specialized early genetic screening and surveillance.

Alternate Names:
FAP; Adenomatous Polyposis Coli

Familial Adenomatous Polyposis (FAP)

Alternate name; see *Familial Adenomatous Polyposis*.

Familial Alobar Holoprosencephaly

An inherited or familial form of alobar holoprosencephaly, a severe developmental defect in which the embryonic forebrain fails to divide normally. It may

be associated with major midline facial abnormalities and requires genetic and specialist evaluation.

Familial Benign Pemphigus (Hailey-Hailey Disease)

An inherited disorder caused by impaired calcium handling between epidermal cells, producing recurrent fragile blisters, erosions, and painful fissures in skin folds. Heat, sweating, friction, and infection can trigger flares; it is not contagious.

Familial Chordoma

A familial predisposition to chordoma, a rare malignant tumor arising from remnants of the embryonic notochord. A family history may warrant genetic counseling and evaluation for tumors involving the skull base or spine.

Familial Combined Hyperlipidemia

An inherited tendency to have high LDL cholesterol, high triglycerides, or both, often affecting several relatives. It increases early cardiovascular risk and is managed with lifestyle measures and lipid-lowering treatment when indicated.

Familial Congestive Cardiomyopathy

Older name for familial dilated cardiomyopathy; see *Familial Dilated Cardiomyopathy (FDC)*.

Familial Cutaneous Amyloidosis

An inherited tendency to develop amyloid deposits limited mainly to the skin, often producing itchy lichen or rippled macular lesions. The specific pattern and associated systemic risk require dermatologic assessment.

Familial Dilated Cardiomyopathy (FDC)

A form of dilated cardiomyopathy that occurs in multiple family members, often because of an inherited genetic change. It causes enlargement and weakened pumping of the left ventricle; inheritance, age of onset, and severity vary, and some relatives with a disease-associated variant may have no symptoms.

Familial Dysautonomia

An inherited nerve disorder affecting sensation and automatic functions such as blood pressure, heart rate, sweating, tears, digestion, and swallowing. Symptoms may include dizziness, temperature problems, repeated lung infections, and poor growth.

Familial Dysbetalipoproteinemia

An inherited disorder in which the body clears certain cholesterol- and triglyceride-rich particles poorly. It can cause high blood fats, yellowish skin deposits, and premature artery disease, especially with other metabolic risk factors.

Familial Emphysema

Emphysema caused or strongly predisposed by an inherited disorder, especially alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency. It can occur at a younger age and may be worsened by smoking or occupational exposures.

Familial Hypercholesterolaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Familial Hypercholesterolemia*.

Familial Hypercholesterolemia

An inherited genetic disorder that prevents the body from effectively clearing low-density lipoprotein (LDL, or 'bad') cholesterol from the bloodstream. This leads to exceptionally high cholesterol levels from birth, causing fatty deposits to accumulate in tendons (xanthomas), around the eyes, and in coronary arteries, dramatically increasing the risk of early heart disease and heart attacks at a young age.

Familial Hypertriglyceridemia

An inherited tendency toward high blood triglycerides, often worsened by diabetes, obesity, alcohol, or certain medicines. Very high levels can cause abdominal pain, eruptive skin bumps, and acute pancreatitis.

Familial Hypocalciuric Hypercalcemia

An inherited condition causing lifelong, usually mild high blood calcium with low urinary calcium. People often have no symptoms, and recognizing it prevents

unnecessary parathyroid surgery; specialist testing may confirm the diagnosis.

Familial Jaundice

Jaundice caused by an inherited disorder of bilirubin production, conjugation, transport, or excretion. Examples include Gilbert syndrome, Crigler-Najjar syndrome, Dubin-Johnson syndrome, and Rotor syndrome.

Familial Lichen Amyloidosis (Type IX)

A hereditary form of primary localized cutaneous amyloidosis in which amyloid deposits in the skin cause intensely itchy, thickened, rippled, or hyperpigmented lesions, usually on the shins or upper back.

Familial Lipoprotein Lipase Deficiency

A rare inherited disorder in which triglycerides cannot be broken down normally. It causes extremely high triglycerides, recurrent pancreatitis, abdominal pain, and yellow-red skin bumps and requires specialist dietary and medical care.

Familial Mediterranean Fever

Usually an autosomal recessive inherited inflammatory disorder, often associated with changes in the *MEFV* gene, causing repeated short attacks of fever with abdominal, chest, or joint pain. Without treatment, ongoing inflammation can damage the kidneys; preventive medicine can reduce attacks and complications.

Familial Multiple Lipomatosis

An inherited tendency to develop many soft, slow-growing, usually painless fatty lumps under the skin, often on the trunk and limbs. They are generally benign; lumps may be painful, rapidly growing, or unusual.

Familial Multiple Polyposis

An older name for familial adenomatous polyposis, an inherited disorder causing numerous adenomatous colorectal polyps and a very high risk of colorectal cancer without appropriate surveillance and preventive treatment.

Familial Multiple Trichoepithelioma

An inherited condition causing many benign tumors from hair follicles, usually small skin-colored facial bumps. They may increase over time and can affect appearance; treatment is chosen according to number, size, and location.

Familial Paroxysmal Peritonitis

An inherited inflammatory disorder causing repeated short attacks of fever with severe abdominal, chest, or joint pain. Without treatment, ongoing inflammation can damage the kidneys; preventive treatment can reduce attacks and complications.

Alternate Names:
Familial Mediterranean Fever

Familial Partial Lipodystrophy

A group of inherited disorders involving selective loss of subcutaneous fat, usually from the limbs and buttocks, with relative fat accumulation in areas such as the face, neck, or trunk. Abnormal fat distribution can lead to insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, and fatty liver.

Familial Primary Pulmonary Hypertension

Heritable pulmonary arterial hypertension caused by pathogenic variants, most often involving the *BMPR2* pathway. Progressive narrowing of pulmonary arteries increases right-heart strain and can cause breathlessness, fainting, or right-heart failure.

Familial Renal Amyloidosis

An inherited amyloidosis in which a variant protein, often transthyretin or another hereditary amyloid precursor, deposits in the kidneys and sometimes the nerves, heart, or other organs. Proteinuria and progressive kidney dysfunction may occur; genetic and specialist evaluation guides care.

Familial Testotoxicosis

An inherited condition in which boys produce excess testosterone without normal brain stimulation. It causes early sexual development, rapid growth, and advanced bone age but may reduce adult height without treatment.

Familial Tremor

A tremor affecting more than one family member, often reflecting inherited essential tremor or another genetic movement disorder. The pattern, age of onset, medicines, and associated neurologic findings help identify the cause.

Family Involvement

Participation of family members or chosen support people in healthcare planning, treatment, rehabilitation, or daily care, with the patient's permission and attention to privacy, safety, preferences, and caregiver burden.

Family Medicine

The medical specialty providing first-contact, continuous, comprehensive care for individuals, families, and communities throughout life. It addresses preventive, acute, chronic, and behavioral health needs across organ systems, considers family and social context, and coordinates care with other health professionals and community services.

Alternate Names:
Family Practice; Family and General Medicine

Family Physician

A physician trained in family medicine who provides first-contact, continuous, comprehensive care for people of all ages. Family physicians address preventive, acute, and chronic health needs, consider physical and social context, and coordinate care across settings and specialties.

Common name: Family Doctor

Family Planning

Personal and healthcare decisions about whether and when to have children. It includes contraception, fertility care, preconception health, pregnancy planning, and support for informed reproductive choices.

Family Study

A structured review of health information in relatives to understand how a disease or trait occurs in a family. It may include family history, medical records, examination, genetic counseling, or testing.

Family Therapy

Counseling involving family members or other close relationships to improve communication, manage conflict, and support recovery. It may help with mental illness, addiction, chronic disease, caregiving stress, or family adjustment.

Famophos

An organophosphate insecticide that can poison the nervous system by blocking acetylcholinesterase. Exposure may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, pinpoint pupils, muscle weakness, breathing failure, or death.

Famotidine

A medicine that blocks histamine signals to reduce stomach-acid production. It treats reflux, heartburn, and ulcers; dose reduction may be needed in kidney disease, and headache, diarrhea, or confusion can occur.

Fanconi Anemia

An inherited disorder affecting DNA repair and bone-marrow blood-cell production. It may cause low blood counts, infections, bleeding, short stature, birth differences, organ problems, and a high risk of leukemia or other cancers.

Fanconi-Bickel Syndrome

A rare autosomal recessive glycogen storage disease caused by mutations in the *SLC2A2* gene encoding the GLUT2 glucose/galactose transporter, characterized by hepatomegaly, glycogen accumulation, proximal renal tubular dysfunction (renal Fanconi syndrome), and severe growth failure.

Fanconi Syndrome

A kidney-tubule disorder causing excess loss of glucose, phosphate, bicarbonate, amino acids, and other substances in urine. It can lead to dehydration, abnormal blood acidity, weak bones, poor growth, or kidney disease.

FAP

Abbreviation; see *Familial Adenomatous Polyposis*.

Farad

The standard unit of electrical capacitance, equal to one coulomb per volt. It is used in medical equipment and electrophysiology to describe how much electrical charge a component can store.

Farber Lipogranulomatosis

A rare inherited storage disorder caused by deficient acid ceramidase. Fatty material accumulates and may cause painful skin lumps, joint stiffness, hoarseness, bone changes, breathing problems, and neurologic disease.

Farmer Lung

Alternate spelling; see *Farmer's Lung*.

Farmer's Lung

Lung inflammation caused by repeatedly inhaling moldy hay, grain, or other farm dust. It can cause fever, cough, chills, and breathlessness hours after exposure and may lead to permanent scarring if exposure continues.

Alternate Names:
Moldy Hay Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis

Farsightedness

A focusing problem in which close objects look blurred because light would focus behind the retina. It may cause eyestrain or headaches and is usually corrected with glasses or contact lenses.

Alternate Names:
Hyperopia; Hypermetropia

Fascia

A sheet or band of connective tissue that surrounds, supports, attaches, or separates muscles and other body structures. Fascia forms layers beneath the skin and around deeper structures, including muscles and organs.

Fascia Adherens

A strong connection joining neighboring cells, especially heart-muscle cells. It links the internal contractile framework of one cell to the membrane of another so force can pass through the tissue.

Fascia Lata

The deep, dense fibrous connective tissue investing sheath of the thigh, which encloses thigh musculature and thickens laterally to form the iliotibial tract, continuous superiorly with the inguinal ligament and fascia of the gluteus maximus.

Fascial Loop

A loop or sling made from a person's tissue or synthetic material to support a body structure. For example, a sling may support the urethra in selected treatment of stress urinary incontinence.

Fascicle

A small bundle of fibers. In skeletal muscle, it is a bundle of muscle fibers surrounded by connective tissue. In a peripheral nerve, it is a bundle of nerve fibers.

Alternate Names:
Fascicles

Fasciculation

A brief, involuntary twitch caused by spontaneous contraction of muscle fibers in a single motor unit (one motor nerve cell and the fibers it controls). It may be visible under the skin and usually causes little or no movement of a joint. Fasciculations can occur in healthy people or with disorders affecting motor nerves; by themselves, they do not identify the cause.

Alternate Names:
Fasciculations

Fasciculus Cuneatus

The lateral ascending white matter sensory tract of the posterior (dorsal) column of the spinal cord, present above thoracic level T6, carrying conscious proprioception, vibratory sense, and fine discriminative touch from the upper trunk, neck, and upper extremities to the nucleus cuneatus of the medulla.

Fasciculus Gracilis

The medial ascending white matter sensory tract of the posterior (dorsal) column of the spinal cord, present throughout the entire length of the spinal cord, conveying conscious proprioception, vibration,

and fine discriminative touch from the lower extremities and lower trunk to the nucleus gracilis of the medulla.

Fasciitis

Inflammation of the connective tissue around muscles and other structures. It may be localized, as in plantar fasciitis, or rapidly destructive, as in necrotizing infection requiring emergency surgery and antibiotics.

Fasciola

A genus of parasitic flatworms, or liver flukes, that infect some animals and people. Infection is acquired by swallowing immature parasites on contaminated water plants or water and may affect the liver and bile ducts.

Fasciola Hepatica

A liver fluke that infects people after contaminated aquatic plants or water are swallowed. Immature worms migrate through the liver, while adult worms live in bile ducts and can cause pain, fever, or obstruction.

Fascioliasis

Infection with liver flukes after eating contaminated aquatic plants or drinking contaminated water. It may cause fever, right-upper-abdominal pain, enlarged liver, or high eosinophils and later cause bile-duct pain, infection, or blockage.

Fasciolopsis

A genus of large intestinal flukes that can infect people who eat contaminated aquatic plants. Heavy infection may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, swelling, poor nutrition, or intestinal obstruction.

Fasciolopsis Buski

A large intestinal fluke acquired by eating aquatic plants carrying immature parasites. Heavy infection may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, intestinal inflammation, malnutrition, or swelling.

Fasciotomy

Emergency surgery that cuts tight fascia to release dangerous pressure in a muscle compartment. It may prevent permanent nerve and muscle damage after crush injury, fracture, burns, or loss and return of blood flow.

Fast Heart Rate

A heart rate faster than expected for a person's age and activity. Exercise, fever, pain, stress, dehydration, anemia, medicines, or an abnormal rhythm may cause it; chest pain or fainting may accompany serious causes.

Fasting

Going without food, and sometimes without drinks, for a defined period. It may be required before blood tests, anesthesia, surgery, or certain procedures, or undertaken for personal or religious reasons.

Fasting Blood Glucose

The blood glucose concentration measured after at least eight hours without calories. It is used to screen for and diagnose diabetes and prediabetes.

Fasting Lipid Profile

A blood test measuring cholesterol and triglycerides after a period without food. It helps assess cardiovascular risk and guide treatment; fasting is particularly useful when triglycerides need accurate measurement.

Alternate Names:
Lipid Panel; Blood Lipid Screen

Fasting Plasma Glucose Test

A blood test measuring blood glucose after fasting, usually at least eight hours. It helps identify diabetes or prediabetes and is interpreted with repeat testing or other results when needed.

Fast-Twitch Fiber

A muscle fiber capable of quick, powerful contraction but more rapid fatigue than a slow-twitch fiber. It supports sprinting, jumping, lifting, and other brief high-intensity activity.

Alternate Names:
Type II Muscle Fiber

Fat

An energy-rich lipid, usually a triglyceride made of glycerol and three fatty acids. Fats store energy, provide insulation, and help the body absorb vitamins A, D, E, and K. Dietary fats include saturated, monounsaturated, polyunsaturated, and trans fats.

Fatal Catatonia

An older term for malignant catatonia, a life-threatening form of catatonia with severe movement or behavior changes and unstable body functions such as temperature, heart rate, or blood pressure.

Fatal Familial Insomnia

A very rare inherited prion disease, usually caused by a disease-causing variant in one copy of the *PRNP* gene. Misfolded prion protein damages the thalamus and other brain areas involved in sleep and automatic body functions. It causes progressively severe loss of normal sleep, along with problems such as sweating, abnormal heart rate or blood pressure, temperature changes, weight loss, impaired movement, and changes in thinking. The disease usually begins in adulthood, progresses over time, and is fatal.

Fat Embolism

Entry of fat droplets into the bloodstream, usually after major trauma, a thigh or pelvic fracture, or orthopedic surgery. It may cause breathing difficulty, confusion, rash, or low oxygen and can become life-threatening.

Fat Embolism Syndrome

A rare, serious illness that can develop after a major bone injury, especially a long-bone or pelvic fracture. It usually begins within a few days and may cause low blood oxygen, breathing problems, confusion, or a pinpoint rash; not every person has all of these findings.

Alternate Names:
FES

Fatigue

Ongoing tiredness or low energy that makes daily activities harder and may not get better with rest. It can be caused by poor sleep, anemia, infection, hormone or other health problems, medicines, or low mood.

Fat Measurement

Estimation of body-fat amount or distribution using methods such as skinfolds, bioimpedance, DEXA, imaging, or laboratory analysis. Results vary by method and depend on overall health, strength, and metabolic findings.

Fat Necrosis

Death of fat cells, often after pancreatitis, injury, or breast surgery. It can cause pain, inflammation, or a firm lump that resembles cancer on examination or imaging and may require testing to distinguish the cause.

Fat Necrosis Of The Breast

Death of fat cells in the breast, often after injury, surgery, or radiation therapy. It may form a firm lump or calcifications that can resemble breast cancer on examination or imaging.

Fat Pad

A localized cushion of fatty tissue that protects, supports, insulates, or permits movement around an organ or joint. Inflammation or injury of a fat pad can cause localized pain and swelling.

Fat-Soluble Toxins

Poisonous chemicals that dissolve in body fat and may remain for a long time. Some pesticides, industrial chemicals, polychlorinated biphenyls, and dioxins can accumulate after repeated exposure and harm several organs.

Fat-Soluble Vitamin

A vitamin that dissolves in fat and can be stored in body tissues. Vitamins A, D, E, and K are fat-soluble; deficiency or excessive supplementation can cause illness.

Fat-Soluble Vitamins

Plural form; see *Fat-Soluble Vitamin*.

Fatty Acid

A fundamental building block of fats in the body and in food. Fatty acids consist of chains of carbon and hydrogen atoms and serve as a major source of concentrated energy and essential components of cell membranes. They are categorized as saturated (commonly solid at room temperature and found in animal products) or unsaturated (commonly liquid and found in plant oils, nuts, and fish), as well as essential fatty acids (such as omega-3 and omega-6) that the body cannot manufacture on its own.

Alternate Names:
Fatty Acids

Fatty Acid Oxidation

The cellular breakdown of fatty acids through several pathways to produce energy or other metabolites. Beta-oxidation is the main energy-producing pathway and occurs in mitochondria and peroxisomes; alpha- and omega-oxidation process selected fatty acids by different routes.

Fatty Acid Oxidation Disorder

An inherited disorder in which cells cannot use certain fats normally for energy. Fasting or illness may cause low blood sugar, vomiting, muscle breakdown, weakness, heart problems, or sudden metabolic illness.

Fatty Acids

Plural form; see *Fatty Acid*.

Fatty Acid Synthase

A group of linked enzymes that helps cells make fatty acids, especially palmitate. These fatty acids are used for energy storage, cell membranes, and other cellular functions.

Fatty Acid Synthesis

The metabolic production of fatty acids from smaller carbon-containing molecules, mainly through acetyl-CoA and malonyl-CoA. It supports the formation of energy stores, cell membranes, and signaling molecules.

Fatty Degeneration

Abnormal buildup of fat inside cells, especially liver cells, caused by metabolic problems, alcohol, toxins, poor nutrition, obesity, or other injury. The change may reverse or progress to inflammation and scarring.

Fatty Liver

Alternate name; see *Fatty Liver Disease*.

Fatty Liver Disease

Steatotic liver disease (SLD), commonly called fatty liver disease, is excess fat in liver cells. Causes include metabolic risk factors, alcohol, medicines, and other conditions. Metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD) is one subtype; inflammation and liver-cell injury in this subtype are called metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH). Some forms can progress to scarring, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer.

Alternate Names:
Hepatic Steatosis; Steatotic Liver Disease

Fatty Streak

An early artery-wall change in which cholesterol-rich immune cells collect beneath the lining. It can be an early stage of atherosclerosis, although some fatty streaks never progress to a harmful plaque.

Favism

Rapid destruction of red blood cells after eating fava beans, usually in a person with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency. It may cause jaundice, dark urine, weakness, breathlessness, or severe anemia.

Favre-Racouchot Syndrome

A benign chronic-sun-damage disorder in which solar elastosis is accompanied by open or closed comedones and small epidermal cysts, usually around the temples, outer eyes, cheeks, or lateral neck. It is associated with photoaging and sometimes smoking.

Favus

A long-lasting fungal infection of the scalp, usually causing yellow cup-shaped crusts around hairs. Without treatment it can destroy follicles and cause permanent scarring hair loss.

Fc Receptor

A protein on an immune cell that binds the tail end of an antibody. This helps the cell recognize, ingest, or destroy the antibody's target and can also influence inflammation.

Fear

An emotional and body response to a perceived threat that prepares a person to protect themselves. Persistent or excessive fear can cause avoidance, panic, sleep problems, and impaired daily functioning.

Fears

Plural form; see *Fear*.

Febrile

Relating to fever, a temporary rise in body temperature usually caused by infection, inflammation, or another illness. Fever differs from heat-related hyperthermia; severe illness, dehydration, confusion, or fever with very low white cells can indicate serious disease.

Febrile Convulsion

Older term; see *Febrile Seizure*.

Febrile Convulsions

Alternate plural form; see *Febrile Seizure*.

Febrile Neutropenia

Fever in a person with neutropenia, defined as a single oral temperature of at least 38.3°C (101°F) or a temperature of at least 38.0°C (100.4°F) sustained for 1 hour, with an absolute neutrophil count below 500 cells/µL or expected to fall below that level within 48 hours. It is associated with increased risk of serious infection.

Febrile Seizure

A brief seizure or convulsion in an infant or young child (most commonly between 6 months and 5 years of age) triggered by a high fever, typically caused by a common childhood viral infection like the flu or an ear infection. While frightening for parents to witness, most febrile seizures last only a few minutes, do not signify epilepsy or brain damage, and leave no lasting harm.

Alternate Names:
Fever-Induced Seizure; Febrile Convulsion; Febrile Seizures

Febrile Seizures

Alternate plural form; see *Febrile Seizure*.

Febuxostat

A medicine that lowers uric-acid production for long-term prevention of gout attacks. It does not relieve sudden gout pain immediately and may require monitoring for liver problems and cardiovascular risk.

FEC

Abbreviation; see *FEC Protocol*.

Fecal Calprotectin

A stool test measuring a protein released during intestinal inflammation. A raised result can support evaluation for inflammatory bowel disease, but infection, medicines, age, and other conditions can also raise it.

Fecal Calprotectin Test

A stool test that measures calprotectin, a protein released by neutrophils during mucosal inflammation, used to differentiate inflammatory bowel disease from functional gastrointestinal disorders; see *Fecal Calprotectin*.

Fecal Culture

Laboratory testing that grows bacteria from a stool sample to investigate infectious diarrhea. It may identify a treatable cause and guide antibiotics, but some infections require toxin, molecular, or parasite

testing instead.

Fecal Elastase

A stool test estimating whether the pancreas releases enough digestive enzymes. A low result may suggest pancreatic insufficiency, causing poor digestion, greasy stools, weight loss, or vitamin deficiency.

Fecal Fat

Measurement of excess fat in stool. High fecal fat suggests poor digestion or absorption from pancreatic disease, reduced bile, intestinal disease, or another condition and may explain greasy, difficult-to-flush stools.

Fecal Immunochemical Test

A stool screening test that detects human blood, mainly from the lower intestine, using antibodies. A positive result does not diagnose cancer but usually requires colon evaluation, often colonoscopy.

Fecal Impaction

A large, hard mass of stool trapped in the rectum or colon. It may cause pain, abdominal swelling, nausea, urinary symptoms, bowel blockage, or watery leakage around the mass; treatment can involve manual or procedural removal.

Fecal Incontinence

Inability to control passage of stool or gas, ranging from soiling to complete loss of bowel control. Causes include diarrhea, constipation, sphincter injury, nerve disease, rectal prolapse, and cognitive impairment.

Alternate Names:
Accidental Bowel Leakage

Fecalith

A hard mass of dried stool, often in the appendix or colon. It may contribute to appendicitis, blockage, inflammation, or perforation.

Fecal Lactoferrin

A protein released mainly by neutrophils during intestinal inflammation. A stool test can help distinguish inflammatory bowel disease from noninflammatory conditions, but infection and other causes of inflammation can also raise the result.

Fecal Microbiota Transplant

Alternate name; see *Fecal Microbiota Transplantation*.

Fecal Microbiota Transplantation

Transfer of processed fecal material from a screened donor into a recipient's gastrointestinal tract to modify the intestinal microbiota, using routes such as colonoscopy, enema, or capsules. It is used chiefly to prevent recurrence of *Clostridioides difficile* infection after antibiotic treatment. Transmission of infectious agents is a recognized risk; regulated microbiota-based products are related but distinct therapies.

Alternate Names:
Fecal Microbiota Transplant; Fecal Transplant; FMT

Fecal Occult Blood Test

A stool test that detects blood too small to see. It may screen for colorectal cancer or investigate digestive-tract bleeding, but it does not identify the cause; a positive result usually requires further colon evaluation.

Fecal Smear

Examination of a thin stool sample with a microscope or stain. Depending on the test, it may help identify parasites, inflammatory cells, blood, fat, or other abnormalities.

Fecal Transplant

Alternate name; see *Fecal Microbiota Transplantation*.

Fecaluria

Stool, gas, or a fecal smell in urine, usually indicating an abnormal connection between the intestine and urinary tract. It often accompanies recurrent urinary infection.

FECD

Abbreviation; see *Fuchs' Dystrophy*.

Feces

Solid or semisolid waste passed from the bowel, containing water, undigested material, bacteria, shed cells, and metabolic waste. Changes in stool can provide clues about digestion, bleeding, infection, or inflammation.

Fecolith

Alternate spelling; see *Fecalith*.

FEC Protocol

A chemotherapy regimen combining fluorouracil, epirubicin, and cyclophosphamide for selected cancers. Important adverse effects include low blood counts, infection, nausea, hair loss, mouth sores, infertility, and heart damage.

Fecundity

The biological capacity to reproduce. It depends on factors affecting either partner, including reproductive anatomy, hormones, age, and overall health; it differs from fecundability, the chance of conception in a given cycle.

Feedback

Information about a system's output that changes later activity. Negative feedback stabilizes functions such as temperature, glucose, and hormones, while positive feedback strengthens processes such as labor contractions.

Feedback Inhibition

A control process in which the end product of a chemical pathway slows an earlier step. This prevents unnecessary buildup of the product and helps cells use nutrients and energy efficiently.

Feedback Mechanism

A regulatory process in which a system's result influences what happens next. Negative feedback maintains stability, while positive feedback amplifies a response until a defined endpoint is reached.

Feeding Jejunostomy

Placement of a feeding tube into the jejunum, part of the small intestine, when eating or stomach feeding is unsafe or impossible. It provides nutrition but can cause infection, blockage, leakage, or bowel injury.

Feeding Methods

Ways of providing food or liquid, including breast or bottle feeding, oral feeding, tube feeding, and intravenous nutrition. The safest method depends on swallowing ability, age, illness, and nutritional needs.

Feeding Poor

Taking too little food or fluid for age or health needs. In an infant it may signal illness, swallowing difficulty, breathing problems, pain, reflux, or developmental difficulty, especially when persistent.

Feeding Tube

A flexible tube used to deliver nutrition, fluids, or medicines to the stomach or intestine when eating is inadequate or unsafe. Risks include blockage, leakage, infection, aspiration, and injury.

Feingold Diet

A restrictive diet that avoids certain food additives and some naturally occurring chemicals, promoted for behavior or attention problems. Evidence of benefit is limited, and restriction can cause nutritional problems without professional guidance.

Felbamate

An antiseizure medicine reserved for selected severe or drug-resistant epilepsy. It can rarely cause life-threatening bone-marrow failure or liver failure, so specialist prescribing and regular blood and liver tests are essential.

Felodipine

A calcium-channel blocker that relaxes artery walls and lowers blood pressure. It may cause ankle swelling, flushing, headache, fast heartbeat, or gum enlargement.

Felon

A painful bacterial infection in the fleshy fingertip, often after a small puncture. Pus and pressure can damage tissue, bone, or tendons; treatment may involve drainage and antibiotics.

Felty's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Felty Syndrome*.

Felty Syndrome

A rare complication of long-standing rheumatoid arthritis involving a very low neutrophil count and often an enlarged spleen. It increases infection risk and requires specialist treatment of arthritis and neutropenia.

Female

Describing the sex category generally associated with ovaries, eggs, and female reproductive anatomy. Biological traits vary among individuals, and sex, gender identity, and gender expression are distinct concepts.

Female Athlete Triad

A spectrum of interrelated problems in physically active girls and women involving energy deficiency, altered menstrual function, and impaired bone health. Energy deficiency occurs when intake is insufficient for exercise and other needs, with or without disordered eating. The components vary in severity and need not all be present; bone effects include reduced density and bone stress injury.

Female Breast

A mammary gland and its skin, fat, connective tissue, ducts, and lobules on the front of the chest. Its structure changes with age, hormones, pregnancy, breastfeeding, and body composition.

Female Circumcision

Older and potentially misleading term; see *Female Genital Mutilation*.

Female Condom

Alternate name; see *Internal Condom*.

Female Condoms

Plural form; see *Internal Condom*.

Female Genitalia

The external and internal reproductive organs, including the vulva, vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, and ovaries. These structures support urination, sexual function, menstruation, fertility, pregnancy, and birth.

Female Genital Mutilation

Partial or total removal of external female genitalia, or other injury to female genital organs, for nonmedical reasons. It has no health benefit and can cause bleeding, infection, urinary and sexual problems, childbirth complications, and lasting physical and psychological harm.

Female Genital Sores

Ulcers, blisters, or raw areas on the vulva, vagina, cervix, or nearby skin. Causes include infections, inflammatory skin conditions, injury, and, less often, cancer.

Alternate Names:
Female Genital Ulcers; Vulvar Ulcers; Vulvar Ulcerations

Female Gonad

An ovary, the reproductive gland that stores and releases eggs and produces hormones including estrogen and progesterone.

Female Infertility

Difficulty achieving pregnancy because of problems with ovulation, ovarian reserve, fallopian tubes, uterus, hormones, or other factors. Clinical evaluation may include both partners and timing depends on duration of trying and relevant risk factors.

Alternate Names:
Female Sterility; Subfertility in Women

Female Orgasmic Disorder

Persistent or recurrent difficulty achieving orgasm that causes personal distress. It may be lifelong or acquired and can relate to health conditions,

medicines, mood, trauma, sexual pain, stimulation, or relationship factors.

Alternate Names:
Anorgasmia; Inhibited Female Orgasm

Female Pattern Baldness

Gradual scalp hair thinning, usually widest near the part or crown, influenced by genes and hormones. New or rapid hair loss can also be associated with iron deficiency, thyroid disease, medicines, and other causes.

Female Pelvis

The pelvic bones and soft tissues in a person with typical female anatomy. It is often broader with a wider outlet than typical male anatomy, but substantial individual variation exists.

Female Phenotype

The observable anatomical, physiologic, and developmental traits associated with female sex. These traits vary with genes, hormones, development, age, and individual biology.

Female Reproductive Organs

Female reproductive organs include the ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, cervix, vagina, and external genitalia, which support hormones, ovulation, menstruation, pregnancy, and birth.

Female Reproductive System

The ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, cervix, vagina, vulva, and related hormones. It supports egg release, menstruation, pregnancy, birth, and sexual function and can be affected by developmental, hormonal, infectious, structural, or cancerous disorders.

Female Self-Catheterization

Intermittent insertion and removal of a catheter through the female urethra to empty the bladder when normal urination is inadequate, reducing retention and protecting kidney function.

Female Sexual Dysfunction

A broad term for persistent or recurrent difficulty with sexual desire, arousal, lubrication, orgasm, or pain that causes clinically significant distress. Medical conditions, medicines, mood, trauma, relationships, and life changes may contribute.

Alternate Names:
FSD

Female Sexual Interest/Arousal Disorder

Persistent or recurrent low sexual interest or arousal causing personal distress. Medical conditions, medicines, mood, trauma, pain, relationship factors, hormonal changes, and other social or psychological factors may contribute.

Female Urethral Meatus

The external opening of the female urethra, through which urine leaves the body; it is located anterior and superior to the vaginal opening.

Female Urethral Opening

The opening through which urine leaves the female urethra, located in the vulvar vestibule in front of the vaginal opening. Its position and appearance may vary normally.

Feminization

Development of physical or hormonal traits commonly associated with female puberty, such as breast growth or reduced body hair. It may be normal, part of gender-affirming treatment, or caused by hormones, medicines, or disease.

Femoral

Relating to the femur or thigh, including the thigh bone, artery, vein, nerve, or neck of the femur.

Femoral Anteversion

An inward twist of the thigh bone that turns the knees or feet inward, often noticed in childhood. It commonly improves with growth; persistent pain, severe asymmetry, or walking problems may occur.

Femoral Artery

A major artery carrying blood through the groin and thigh to the leg. Its pulse can be felt in the

groin, and it is used for some catheter procedures; injury or blockage can threaten the limb.

Femoral Canal

The medial, smallest compartment of the femoral sheath, measuring approximately 1.3 cm in length, containing loose connective tissue, lymphatic vessels, and the deep inguinal lymph node of Cloquet; site of femoral herniation below the inguinal ligament.

Femoral Hernia

A relatively uncommon type of groin hernia that occurs when a small portion of intestine or fatty tissue pushes through a natural weakness in the groin into the femoral canal (the passageway for the main blood vessels entering the upper thigh). It appears as a bulge in the upper thigh just below the groin crease. Because the canal is narrow and rigid, femoral hernias carry a higher risk of becoming trapped (incarcerated) or having their blood supply cut off (strangulated) compared to other groin hernias.

Femoral Head Osteonecrosis

Alternate name; see *Avascular Necrosis Of The Femoral Head*.

Femoral Neck Fracture

A break in the narrow part of the thighbone just below its ball-shaped head. It is a type of hip fracture and can cause hip or groin pain and difficulty standing or walking.

Femoral Hernia Repair

Surgery that returns trapped tissue to the abdomen and closes or reinforces the opening in the groin. Repair is commonly performed because femoral hernias can become trapped or strangulated.

Femoral Nerve

A large nerve from the lower back that supplies muscles that flex the hip and straighten the knee and provides sensation to the front thigh and inner leg. Injury can cause weakness, numbness, or falls.

Femoral Nerve Dysfunction

Reduced function of the nerve supplying the front thigh and knee-straightening muscles. It can cause hip or knee weakness and altered sensation and may result from diabetes, compression, injury, surgery, or pelvic disease.

Femoral Nerve Stretch Test

A neurological examination manoeuvre used to assess for upper lumbar nerve root irritation (L2, L3, or L4) or femoral neuropathy. With the patient prone, the examiner passively flexes the knee and extends the hip; reproduction of pain radiating down the anterior thigh indicates a positive test.

Alternate Names:
Prone Knee Bending Test; Reverse Straight Leg Raise

Femoral Neuropathy

Damage to the femoral nerve causing weakness in hip flexion or knee extension and numbness or pain in the front thigh or inner leg. Causes include diabetes, injury, bleeding, compression, and pelvic disease.

Femoral Pulse

The pulse felt over the femoral artery in the groin. Comparing it with pulses elsewhere helps assess blood flow to the leg and can provide clues about arterial blockage or shock.

Femoral Shaft Fractures

Breaks in the middle portion of the thigh bone, often from high-energy trauma but sometimes from weakened bone. They can cause major blood loss, deformity, and inability to walk; treatment often involves stabilization and surgery.

Femoral Sheath

A funnel-shaped fascial sleeve formed by downward prolongation of the transversalis fascia (anteriorly) and iliac fascia (posteriorly) beneath the inguinal ligament into the femoral triangle, compartmentalized into lateral (femoral artery), intermediate (femoral vein), and medial (femoral canal) spaces.

Femoral Triangle

A triangular area at the upper front of the thigh bordered by the groin ligament and nearby muscles. It contains the femoral nerve, artery, vein, and lymph nodes and is an important examination and access site.

Femoral Vein

The major deep vein of the thigh, carrying blood from the leg toward the pelvis and heart. A clot in it can cause deep-vein thrombosis and pulmonary embolism.

Femoroacetabular Impingement

Alternate name; see *Hip Impingement*.

Femtogram

A unit of mass equal to one quadrillionth of a gram, or 10^{-15} gram. It is used in laboratory measurements of extremely small quantities.

Femtoliter

A unit of volume equal to one quadrillionth of a liter, or 10^{-15} liter. It is used to describe very small laboratory or cellular volumes.

Femur

The thigh bone and the longest, strongest bone in the body. It joins the hip to the knee and includes a head, neck, shaft, and lower end; fractures can threaten mobility and blood supply.

Femur Fracture

A break in the thigh bone caused by trauma or weakened bone. It may cause severe pain, deformity, blood loss, and inability to bear weight; treatment depends on location, alignment, and overall health.

Femur Length

The ultrasound-measured length of a fetus's thigh bone. It helps estimate pregnancy age and assess growth, but interpretation depends on other measurements, family size, pregnancy dating, and possible skeletal or chromosomal conditions.

Fencer's Pose

A posture in which turning the head makes the arm and leg on that side straighten while the opposite arm and leg bend. It is a normal reflex in young infants but may indicate a brain or nerve problem if it persists or appears unexpectedly.

Fenfluramine

A medicine used to reduce seizures in Dravet syndrome and Lennox-Gastaut syndrome. It can reduce appetite and weight and may cause heart-valve disease or high blood pressure in lung arteries, so echocardiograms are required before, during, and after treatment.

Fenitrothion

A poisonous organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness because it disrupts nerve signals.

Fenobucarb

A carbamate insecticide that can cause nerve poisoning after significant absorption, producing sweating, vomiting, small pupils, muscle weakness, breathing difficulty, or seizures.

Fenofibrate

A medicine that lowers blood triglycerides and can modestly change cholesterol levels by increasing the liver's processing of fats. It is used for selected lipid disorders; liver, kidney, muscle, and gallbladder risks require monitoring.

Fenoldopam

A short-acting dopamine D1-receptor agonist used intravenously for severe hypertension in selected settings; it can cause hypotension, flushing, headache, and increased intraocular pressure.

Fenoprofen

Fenoprofen is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain and inflammatory arthritis; gastrointestinal bleeding, renal injury, fluid retention, and cardiovascular events are important risks.

Fenoprofen Calcium Overdose

Taking too much fenoprofen, an anti-inflammatory pain medicine, can cause nausea, vomiting, stomach bleeding, drowsiness, kidney injury, breathing or acid-base problems, seizures, or coma.

Fenoterol

A short-acting beta-2 bronchodilator that relaxes airway muscle and relieves bronchospasm. It may cause tremor, nervousness, low potassium, or a fast or irregular heartbeat and is not approved everywhere.

Fenoxycarb

An insect-growth regulator that imitates juvenile hormone and disrupts development of immature insects. It is used for pest control; some formulations can irritate skin, eyes, or airways.

Fentanyl Citrate

The citrate salt of fentanyl, a potent opioid analgesic used for severe pain and anesthesia; respiratory depression, sedation, dependence, and overdose are major risks.

Fentanyl Derivatives

Strong synthetic opioid medicines related to fentanyl, including sufentanil, remifentanil, and alfentanil. They may relieve severe pain or support anesthesia but can rapidly slow breathing, cause overdose, and produce dependence, so close monitoring is essential.

Fentanyl Vaccine

An investigational vaccine designed to prompt antibodies that bind fentanyl in the bloodstream, limiting its passage into the brain and reducing its opioid effects. Candidate vaccines link a fentanyl-like molecule to an immunogenic carrier to provoke this response. They are being evaluated in early-phase clinical research and are not approved for routine clinical use.

Fenthion

A poisonous organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness because it disrupts nerve signals.

Fermentation

A metabolic process in which microorganisms or cells convert organic substrates without using oxidative respiration, producing products such as acids, alcohols, or gases.

Ferriman-Gallwey Score

A standardized clinical scoring system used to quantify the severity of hirsutism in women by visually grading terminal hair density from zero (absence) to four (extensive) across nine androgen-sensitive body areas, with a total score of eight or higher generally indicating clinical hirsutism.

Alternate Names:
Modified Ferriman-Gallwey Scale; mFG Score

Ferritin

A protein that stores iron inside cells and releases it when needed. Blood ferritin often reflects body iron stores, but inflammation, infection, liver disease, or cancer can raise it even when iron is low.

Ferritin Blood Test

A blood test measuring stored iron indirectly. Low ferritin strongly supports iron deficiency; high ferritin may reflect iron excess, inflammation, infection, liver disease, or cancer and varies with other test results.

Ferritin Test

A blood test measuring ferritin, the primary intracellular iron-storage protein, reflecting total body iron stores; see *Ferritin* and *Iron Studies*.

Ferroptosis

A controlled form of cell death caused by iron-dependent damage to cell fats and failure of antioxidant protection. It differs from apoptosis and ordinary tissue necrosis and is being studied in cancer and other diseases.

Ferrous Sulfate

An oral iron supplement used to prevent or treat iron-deficiency anemia. It may cause nausea, constipation, abdominal discomfort, or dark stools; accidental overdose can be life-threatening, especially in children.

Fertile Period

The several days in a menstrual cycle when sex can result in pregnancy, including the days before and shortly after ovulation. Timing varies, and calendar estimates are not reliable contraception for everyone.

Fertilisation

Union of a sperm and an egg to form a zygote, the first cell of an embryo. It usually occurs in a fallopian tube before the developing embryo moves toward the uterus.

Fertility

The biological ability to conceive and produce offspring. It depends on ovulation, sperm production, reproductive anatomy, hormones, age, general health, and other factors affecting either partner.

Fertility Domain

The part of health concerned with reproductive function, ability to conceive, fertility goals, infertility, preservation of fertility, and related medical, emotional, and social care.

Fertility Drugs

Medicines used to stimulate ovulation, support reproductive treatment, or improve the chance of pregnancy. They can cause side effects and multiple pregnancy; selection and monitoring are individualized.

Fertility Medicine

The clinical field focused on evaluating and treating difficulty conceiving and other disorders of reproductive function. It includes assessment of ovulation, sperm, reproductive anatomy, and hormones, as well as fertility treatments and preservation; it overlaps with reproductive endocrinology and infertility.

Fertility Preservation

Steps taken to protect the possibility of future pregnancy before treatment or disease may damage reproductive function. Options include freezing eggs, embryos, sperm, or selected reproductive tissue, depending on age, timing, and goals.

Fertility Treatment

Medical or procedural care intended to help achieve pregnancy. Options include treating underlying disease, ovulation medicines, surgery, insemination, or in-vitro fertilization, chosen according to cause, age, health, and reproductive goals.

Fertilization

Fusion of sperm and egg genetic material to form a zygote, usually in a fallopian tube. This begins embryonic development, which may continue after the zygote reaches the uterus and implants.

Ferumoxytol

An intravenous iron preparation used for selected adults with iron-deficiency anemia. It can cause allergic reactions, low blood pressure, or iron overload, so monitoring is required during and after infusion.

FESS

Functional endoscopic sinus surgery uses instruments passed through the nostrils to open blocked sinus drainage pathways and remove selected diseased tissue. It may improve chronic sinus disease but can cause bleeding, infection, eye injury, or fluid leakage.

Festinating Gait

Walking with increasingly short, quick steps and a forward-leaning posture, commonly associated with Parkinson disease or other movement disorders. It increases fall risk and may improve with specialist treatment and physical therapy.

Fetal Acid-Base Status

An assessment of a fetus's oxygen supply and blood acidity, often using umbilical-cord blood gases at birth. Results depend on the sampling site, timing, fetal condition, and clinical record.

Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder

A group of lifelong conditions that can occur after alcohol exposure before birth. Effects vary widely and may involve growth, physical development, brain development, learning, memory, attention, behavior, speech, coordination, or everyday functioning. Some people have characteristic facial features, birth defects, or problems with organs such as the heart or kidneys, but these are not present in everyone. The effects can occur even when the person does not have the facial features or growth problems associated with fetal alcohol syndrome.

Alternate Names:
FASD

Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders

Alternate plural form; see *Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder*.

Fetal Alcohol Syndrome

A severe condition caused by maternal alcohol consumption during pregnancy. Because alcohol crosses the placenta freely, it disrupts the developing baby's brain and physical growth. Children with fetal alcohol syndrome typically exhibit a distinctive combination of facial characteristics (such as a smooth philtrum and thin upper lip), low birth weight, small head size, lifelong learning disabilities, and behavioral or social challenges.

Alternate Names:
FAS

Fetal Anatomy Survey

A detailed ultrasound examination, usually in the second trimester, that checks fetal anatomy, growth, placenta, and amniotic fluid. It can detect some structural differences but cannot identify every condition.

Alternate Names:
Level II Ultrasound; Fetal Anomaly Scan

Fetal Anemia

An abnormally low concentration of red blood cells or hemoglobin in a developing fetus, commonly caused by red-cell alloimmunization (Rh disease), fetomaternal hemorrhage, or parvovirus B19 infection, which can lead to high-output cardiac failure and hydrops fetalis.

Fetal Arrhythmia

An irregularity, abnormal acceleration, or slowing of the fetal heart rhythm outside the normal baseline rate of 110 to 160 beats per minute; see *Fetal Bradyarrhythmia* and *Fetal Tachycardia*.

Fetal Attitude

The position of a fetus's head, arms, legs, and trunk in relation to one another. Normal flexion helps birth; unusual extension or flexion can change the presenting part and affect labor.

Fetal Bradyarrhythmia

An unusually slow or irregular fetal heart rhythm. Causes include conduction block, extra beats, maternal or fetal disease, or medicines; persistent abnormalities may reflect fetal or maternal illness.

Fetal Bradycardia

A fetal heart-rate baseline below 110 beats per minute for at least ten minutes. Medicines, maternal illness, fetal heart disease, low oxygen, cord problems, or placental separation may cause it; persistent cases may indicate fetal compromise.

Fetal Circulation

Blood flow before birth in which the placenta supplies oxygen and nutrients and special connections direct much blood around the lungs, which are not yet used for breathing. These connections normally close after birth.

Fetal Death

Death of a fetus before delivery. Medical and legal definitions vary by gestational age and location; care includes confirming the diagnosis, supporting the family, and discussing delivery and follow-up.

Fetal Development

Growth and maturation from the end of the embryonic period until birth. Organs enlarge and mature, movements develop, and body systems gradually

acquire the functions needed after delivery.

Fetal Disease

A disease, structural abnormality, or developmental problem affecting a fetus before birth. Causes include genetic changes, infection, medicines, toxins, and poor placental function; ultrasound and prenatal tests may identify it.

Fetal Distress

An older, imprecise term for findings suggesting possible fetal compromise, usually during labor. Clinicians generally use nonreassuring fetal status and name the specific findings, such as recurrent late heart-rate decelerations, prolonged bradycardia, or a low biophysical profile. The term alone does not establish fetal oxygen deprivation or injury.

Fetal Echocardiography

A specialized ultrasound examination of the fetal heart used to assess cardiac structure, rhythm, and function, including possible congenital heart disease.

Fetal Fibronectin

A protein found where the fetal membranes meet the lining of the uterus. In a pregnant person with symptoms of early labor, testing fluid from the vagina or cervix can help estimate the chance of giving birth soon; a negative result makes birth in the near term less likely but does not rule it out.

Alternate Names:
fFN

Fetal Growth Restriction

Pathologic limitation of fetal growth potential, often associated with placental dysfunction. It may be suspected from small fetal size, slowed growth, or abnormal Doppler findings. Small-for-gestational-age describes size below a percentile cutoff and includes some constitutionally small fetuses; growth restriction can also occur above that cutoff.

Alternate Names:
Intrauterine Growth Restriction; IUGR

Fetal Heart

The developing heart of a fetus, whose rate and rhythm can be assessed by ultrasound or electronic monitoring to evaluate fetal well-being.

Fetal Heart Monitoring

Assessment of fetal heart rate during pregnancy or labor by intermittent auscultation or electronic fetal monitoring. Electronic monitoring may be continuous or intermittent and records the fetal heart rate, often alongside uterine contractions; cardiotocography refers to this electronic recording.

Alternate Names:
Cardiotocography; CTG; Electronic Fetal Monitoring

Fetal Heart Rate

The number of times a fetus's heart beats each minute, usually about 110–160 during pregnancy and labor. It can be checked with a Doppler or electronic monitor; changes may reflect normal activity, medicines, or reduced oxygen.

Fetal Hemoglobin

The main oxygen-carrying protein in a fetus's red blood cells. It binds oxygen more strongly than adult hemoglobin, helping the fetus obtain oxygen from the placenta; its amount normally falls after birth.

Fetal Hydantoin Syndrome

A distinct pattern of congenital malformations resulting from maternal gestational exposure to hydantoin anticonvulsants (predominantly phenytoin). Hallmarks include craniofacial dysmorphism (cleft lip/palate, broad depressed nasal bridge, hypertelorism), hypoplasia of distal phalanges and nails, intrauterine growth restriction, microcephaly, and neurodevelopmental delay.

Alternate Names:
Dilantin Embryopathy; Phenytoin Syndrome

Fetal Hydrops

Abnormal fluid buildup in at least two fetal body areas, such as under the skin, around the lungs or heart, or in the abdomen. It may result from

maternal antibodies attacking fetal red blood cells (immune hydrops) or from other causes (nonimmune hydrops), including anemia, heart disease, infection, or genetic conditions; specialist evaluation is needed.

Fetal Hypoxia

Too little oxygen reaching a fetus before or during birth. Placental disease, maternal breathing or circulation problems, cord compression, or prolonged labor can contribute; abnormal heart-rate patterns may accompany it.

Fetal Kick Counts

Observation and recording of fetal movements during pregnancy to assess changes in the fetus's usual movement pattern. Methods vary; a marked decrease in usual movement may indicate fetal compromise.

Alternate Names:
Kick Counting

Fetal Lie

The direction of a fetus's long body axis compared with the pregnant person's spine. The fetus may lie lengthwise, sideways, or diagonally; a sideways or diagonal position near birth can affect delivery planning.

Fetal Lung Maturity

Development of the fetal lungs, including production of surfactant by type II pneumocytes, which helps keep air sacs open after birth. Amniotic-fluid tests such as the lecithin-to-sphingomyelin ratio or lamellar-body count can estimate surfactant development, but do not measure overall fetal maturity or predict all newborn outcomes.

Alternate Names:
FLM

Fetal Macrosomia

A fetus that is larger than expected, often estimated at 4,000–4,500 grams or more at birth depending on the clinical definition. Diabetes and previous large babies increase risk; complications include difficult birth, injury, and cesarean delivery.

Fetal Malformation

A primary structural defect of an organ, limb, or tissue resulting from an intrinsically abnormal developmental process during prenatal organogenesis; see *Birth Defect*.

Fetal Malpresentation

A fetal presentation other than the usual vertex presentation, including breech, transverse, or oblique lie, which may affect labor and delivery planning.

Fetal-Maternal Erythrocyte Distribution Blood Test

A test that estimates the amount of fetal red blood cells in maternal circulation, helping guide Rh immune globulin dosing after fetomaternal hemorrhage.

Fetal Monitor

A device that records fetal heart rate and, when configured for electronic fetal monitoring, uterine contractions. An external Doppler ultrasound sensor detects the fetal heartbeat, while a tocodynamometer detects uterine contractions. In selected labor settings, a fetal scalp electrode can provide an internal fetal heart-rate signal.

Fetal Monitoring

Assessment of fetal heart rate and, in labor, sometimes uterine contractions to evaluate fetal status. Methods include intermittent auscultation and electronic monitoring; results are interpreted with the clinical circumstances.

Fetal Presentation

The part of the baby positioned to enter the pregnant person's pelvis first. The usual presentation is head first; breech, shoulder, face, brow, and mixed presentations can affect labor and delivery planning.

Fetal Pyelectasis

Mild widening of the urine-collecting area of a fetus's kidney seen on an ultrasound scan. It may go away before birth or be linked to a urinary blockage or another condition, so follow-up depends on its size and other findings.

Fetal Scalp Electrode

A small electrode placed on the fetus's scalp through the cervix to record the heart rate directly during labor. It may give a clearer signal when external monitoring is inadequate but can cause infection, bleeding, or scalp injury.

Fetal Scalp PH Testing

A test that analyzes a small blood sample from the baby's scalp during labor to assess whether reduced oxygen may be causing acid buildup. It may clarify an abnormal fetal heart-rate pattern, but use is limited and depends on local expertise and clinical circumstances.

Fetal Scalp Stimulation

A test during labor in which the baby's scalp is gently touched during a vaginal examination. A brief rise in the baby's heart rate may be reassuring; significance depends on the full heart-rate recording and clinical situation.

Fetal Stage

The fetal stage begins after the embryonic period and continues until birth, characterized mainly by growth and maturation of established organs.

Fetal Tachycardia

A sustained fetal heart-rate baseline above 160 beats per minute for at least 10 minutes. Causes may include maternal fever, infection, medicines, fetal hypoxia, or fetal arrhythmia.

Fetal Tissue

Fetal tissue is tissue from a developing fetus and may be relevant to pregnancy care, pathology, research, transplantation, or genetic testing under applicable ethical and legal rules.

Fetal Ultrasound

Imaging during pregnancy using sound waves to assess the fetus, placenta, fluid, growth, movement, and anatomy. It can estimate gestational age, identify some structural problems, assess growth or blood flow, and guide selected procedures.

Fetal Viability

The possibility that a fetus could survive outside the uterus with intensive medical care. Survival depends on gestational age at birth, fetal size and condition, treatments given before birth, and the availability of neonatal intensive care; no single week marks viability for every pregnancy.

Fetal Weight

An estimate of a fetus's mass, usually calculated from ultrasound measurements. It helps assess growth and identify possible growth restriction or unusually large size, but it is not exact.

Fetishism

A recurrent sexual interest in a nonliving object or a specific non-genital body part. The interest alone is not a mental disorder.

Fetishistic Disorder

A mental-health disorder involving repeated, intense sexual arousal from a nonliving object or a specific non-genital body part, with clinically significant distress or impairment or involvement of harm or lack of consent.

Fetomaternal Hemorrhage

Passage of fetal blood into the pregnant person's bloodstream through the placenta. Small amounts can occur normally, but heavy bleeding across the placenta after trauma, placental separation, or a procedure can cause fetal anemia and affect preventive treatment.

Fetomaternal Transfusion

Movement of fetal blood cells across the placenta into the pregnant person's bloodstream. Small amounts are common, but heavy transfer after trauma, placental problems, or procedures can cause fetal anemia.

Fetor Hepaticus

A musty or sweet breath odor that can occur with severe liver dysfunction when certain substances are not adequately cleared. It is a warning sign requiring evaluation for advanced liver disease and

complications.

Fetoscope

An instrument used to hear or assess the fetal heartbeat through the pregnant person's abdominal wall, especially later in pregnancy.

Fetus

A developing human from the start of the ninth week after fertilization until birth. During this period, established organs grow and mature; medical descriptions may instead use pregnancy weeks counted from the last menstrual period.

FEV1/FVC Ratio

The amount of air forcefully exhaled in the first second divided by the total amount exhaled. A lower-than-expected ratio suggests narrowed airways, but interpretation uses age, sex, height, reference values, and bronchodilator response.

Fever

A regulated rise in body temperature caused by changes in the body's temperature-control system, commonly in response to infection or inflammation. It may also occur with certain medicines, cancers, autoimmune disorders, or other conditions. Fever differs from hyperthermia, in which body temperature rises without a normal change in the temperature set point.

Fever And Headache

Fever with headache may occur with viral illness, influenza, sinus disease, dehydration, meningitis, encephalitis, or other infection. Severe sudden headache, neck stiffness, confusion, rash, seizure, weakness, or reduced consciousness requires emergency assessment.

Fever Blister

Alternate name; see *Cold Sore*.

Fever-Induced Seizure

Alternate name; see *Febrile Seizure*.

Fever Of Unknown Origin

Persistent or recurrent fever whose cause remains unexplained after an appropriate initial evaluation. Causes may include infection, inflammation, cancer, or medicines and require systematic reassessment.

Fexofenadine

An antihistamine used to relieve sneezing, itching, runny nose, and watery eyes from allergies and itching from hives. It usually causes less drowsiness than older antihistamines, but headache or nausea can occur.

Fiber

Dietary fiber is plant material that the small intestine cannot digest. It adds bulk to stool, supports regular bowel movements, and some types help lower blood cholesterol and slow rises in blood glucose.

Fiber Optic

A technology that sends light through thin glass or plastic fibers. Flexible fiber-optic instruments are used in endoscopy to view body passages and guide some minimally invasive procedures.

Fibrates

A group of medicines that mainly lower high triglyceride levels by changing how the liver and tissues handle fats. They can cause indigestion, gallstones, liver problems, or muscle injury, especially with some other lipid medicines.

Fibre

A threadlike structure in the body or another material. In nutrition, fibre is plant material that is not digested in the small intestine and helps regulate bowel movements.

Fibrillary Glomerulonephritis

A rare kidney disease in which abnormal protein fibers collect in the kidney's filtering units. It may cause blood or protein in the urine and declining kidney function; kidney biopsy and a DNAJB9 stain can help confirm the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:

FGN; DNAJB9 Glomerulopathy

Fibrillation

Rapid, disorganized activity of muscle fibers. In the heart, atrial fibrillation causes an irregular rhythm and can lead to blood clots; ventricular fibrillation stops effective pumping.

Fibrin

An insoluble, threadlike protein that forms a mesh at an injured blood vessel. The mesh traps blood cells and strengthens the clot that helps stop bleeding.

Fibrin Degradation Products Blood Test

A blood test that measures fragments released when blood clots are broken down. High levels may occur with widespread clotting, severe infection, liver disease, recent surgery, or pregnancy, so results require clinical interpretation.

Fibrinogen

A blood protein made mainly by the liver that is changed into fibrin during clot formation. Low levels can cause bleeding; levels may rise with inflammation and fall in severe liver disease or widespread clotting.

Fibrinogen Assay

A laboratory test that measures the amount or clotting activity of fibrinogen in blood. It helps investigate unexplained bleeding, abnormal clotting, liver disease, or suspected widespread clotting disorders.

Fibrinogen Blood Test

A blood test measuring fibrinogen, a liver-made protein needed to form blood clots. Low levels may contribute to bleeding, while high levels commonly accompany inflammation, infection, pregnancy, or cardiovascular risk.

Fibrinogen Decreased

A lower-than-normal blood fibrinogen level, which can weaken clot formation and cause bleeding. Causes include inherited deficiency, severe liver disease, major blood loss or transfusion, and widespread activation of clotting.

Fibrinoid

Describing homogeneous, eosinophilic, hyaline-like material in tissue, especially in blood-vessel walls. Its composition varies and is not necessarily fibrin; when associated with vessel-wall necrosis, the lesion is called fibrinoid necrosis.

Fibrinoid Leukodystrophy

An older name associated with Alexander disease, a rare astrocyte disorder in which Rosenthal fibers accumulate and white matter is damaged. Clinical features vary by age and may include developmental regression, seizures, movement problems, or bulbar dysfunction.

Fibrinoid Necrosis

Severe damage to a blood-vessel wall in which blood proteins and immune material collect within the wall. It can occur in some inflammatory vessel diseases and is identified by examining affected tissue.

Fibrinolysis

The natural process that dissolves a blood clot after healing begins. An enzyme called plasmin breaks down fibrin; excessive breakdown can cause bleeding, while insufficient breakdown can allow harmful clots to persist.

Fibrinolytic Agent

A medicine that dissolves a blood clot by helping the body convert plasminogen into plasmin, which breaks down fibrin. It may treat selected emergencies but can cause serious bleeding, including bleeding in the brain.

Fibrinolytic Therapy

Treatment that uses clot-dissolving medicine to restore blood flow in selected emergencies, such as certain strokes, heart attacks, or pulmonary embolisms. The main risk is serious bleeding, so eligibility is assessed urgently.

Alternate Names:
Thrombolytic Therapy; Clot-Dissolving Therapy

Fibrinopeptide A Blood Test

A blood test that measures a protein fragment released when the body begins converting fibrinogen into fibrin. It can indicate clotting activity but is not specific enough to diagnose a condition by itself.

Fibrinous Pericarditis

Inflammation of the sac surrounding the heart, with a sticky protein called fibrin coating its surfaces. It may cause sharp chest pain, a scratchy heart sound, and fluid around the heart.

Fibrin Sealant

A surgical adhesive containing clotting proteins that form a fibrin clot when applied to tissue. It can help control bleeding or seal selected tissues, but it does not replace repair of major blood-vessel injuries.

Fibrin Split Products

Soluble protein fragments released into the bloodstream during plasmin-mediated enzymatic cleavage and degradation of cross-linked fibrin polymers and fibrinogen, elevated in disseminated intravascular coagulation, deep vein thrombosis, and acute pulmonary embolism.

Alternate Names:
FDPs; Fibrin Degradation Products

Fibroadenoma

A common noncancerous breast lump made of glandular and connective tissue. It is usually firm, smooth, movable, and painless, especially in adolescents and young adults; imaging helps distinguish it from other breast masses.

Fibroadenoma Of The Breast

Alternate name; see *Fibroadenoma*.

Fibroblast

A cell that makes collagen and other supporting materials in connective tissue. Fibroblasts help maintain skin, tendons, and organs and become active during wound healing and scar formation.

Fibrocartilage

A tough type of cartilage that combines strength with limited flexibility. It helps absorb pressure and resist pulling in the discs between spinal bones, the pubic joint, and the knee menisci.

Fibrocystic Breast Changes

Common benign changes in breast tissue that may include cysts, fibrous areas, lumpiness, tenderness, or swelling, sometimes varying with the menstrual cycle. The effect on breast cancer risk depends on the tissue pattern; nonproliferative changes alone do not increase risk.

Alternate Names:
Fibrocystic Breast Disease (deprecated historical term)

Fibrocystic Breast Condition

Alternate name; see *Fibrocystic Breast Changes*.

Fibrocystic Breasts

Alternate name; see *Fibrocystic Breast Changes*.

Fibrodysplasia Ossificans Progressiva

A rare inherited disorder in which muscles, tendons, ligaments, and other connective tissues gradually turn into bone. This extra bone forms outside the normal skeleton and can make joints stiff or fixed, restricting movement. Episodes of soft-tissue swelling and inflammation may be followed by permanent bone formation, and injury or invasive procedures can trigger these episodes. The disorder usually becomes noticeable in early childhood and may later limit opening of the mouth or expansion of the rib cage. Most cases are caused by a change in the *ACVR1* gene. A characteristic feature present from birth is a malformed, shortened, or inward-turned big toe.

Alternate Names:
FOP; Stone Man Syndrome

Fibroepithelial Polyp Of The Vulva

A usually noncancerous, soft tissue growth on the vulva or nearby vaginal tissue. It may enlarge during pregnancy or the reproductive years and can cause irritation, bleeding, or discomfort if large.

Fibrofolliculoma

A small, usually noncancerous skin growth arising around a hair follicle, often on the face, neck, or upper trunk. Multiple lesions may occur with an inherited disorder that also raises kidney-tumor risk.

Fibroid

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroids*.

Fibroids

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroids*.

Fibroid Tumor

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroids*.

Fibrolamellar Carcinoma

A rare primary liver cancer that usually affects adolescents and young adults without cirrhosis. It may cause abdominal pain, a mass, weight loss, or abnormal liver tests; imaging and biopsy establish diagnosis and resection is considered when feasible.

Fibrolamellar Hepatocellular Carcinoma

A distinct primary malignant hepatic neoplasm occurring predominantly in adolescents and young adults without pre-existing cirrhosis or viral hepatitis, histologically characterized by large polygonal eosinophilic hepatocytes embedded within dense, lamellar collagenous stroma; associated with a DNAJB1-PRKACA fusion gene.

Fibrolipoma

A usually noncancerous, slow-growing lump made of mature fat and fibrous tissue. It is often painless and lies beneath the skin; lumps may be new or enlarging.

Fibroma

A usually benign tumor made mainly of fibrous connective tissue. Fibromas can develop in skin, soft tissue, bone, or organs; their effects depend on their location and size, and some site-specific forms may recur or interfere with organ function.

Fibroma Of Tendon Sheath

A usually noncancerous, slow-growing lump attached to the covering of a tendon, most often in a finger, hand, or wrist. It is firm and may recur after removal.

Fibromatoses

A group of fibroblast growth disorders that do not spread to distant organs but can recur locally. Superficial forms include palmar and plantar fibromatosis; deep desmoid-type fibromatosis can grow into nearby tissues and impair their function.

Fibromatosis

An overgrowth of connective-tissue cells that does not spread to distant organs but can invade nearby tissue and recur. Desmoid-type disease may cause pain, a firm mass, or impaired organ function.

Fibromuscular Dysplasia

An abnormal structure of medium-sized artery walls, most often in the kidney or neck arteries. It can cause high blood pressure, headache, or stroke, or produce an artery bulge or tear.

Fibromyalgia

A chronic disorder characterized by widespread pain and tenderness throughout the muscles, joints, and soft tissues, accompanied by persistent fatigue, sleep disturbances, and memory or concentration difficulties (often called 'fibro fog'). It is thought to involve heightened sensitivity in the central nervous system, causing the brain to amplify normal pain signals.

Alternate Names:
FMS; Fibromyalgia Syndrome; FM

Fibromyalgia Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Fibromyalgia*.

Fibromyxosarcoma

A rare cancer of soft tissue containing fibrous and jelly-like material. It may present as a growing lump or pain; diagnosis requires tissue examination, and treatment depends on its site and spread.

Fibronectin

A protein found in blood and connective tissue that helps cells attach, move, and organize during tissue repair. It supports wound healing and the structure of tissues around cells.

Fibroproliferation

Excess growth of connective-tissue cells with increased production of scar tissue. It can thicken or stiffen organs, including the lungs, and may develop after injury, inflammation, or surgery.

Fibrosarcoma

A rare cancer arising from cells that make fibrous connective tissue. It usually develops in deep soft tissue or bone and may cause a growing mass, pain, or reduced movement.

FibroScan

A painless ultrasound-based test that estimates liver stiffness. Greater stiffness can suggest scarring, but inflammation, congestion, obesity, or fluid in the abdomen can affect accuracy and results may need other tests.

Fibrosing Alopecia

Hair loss caused by inflammation and permanent scarring of hair follicles. The affected skin may look smooth or shiny, and regrowth is unlikely once follicles are destroyed; treatment may limit progression.

Fibrosing Cholangitis

Chronic inflammation and scarring of the bile ducts, most commonly referring to primary sclerosing cholangitis. It can cause cholestasis, itching, jaundice, recurrent bacterial cholangitis, cirrhosis, and increased risk of bile-duct cancer.

Fibrosis

Excess formation of scar tissue after ongoing injury or inflammation. Fibrosis can make an organ stiff and reduce its function, such as causing breathlessness in the lungs or impaired filtration in the kidneys.

Fibrous Cavernositis

Inflammation and fibrosis of the erectile tissue of the penis, which may cause pain, swelling, erectile dysfunction, or curvature. Infection, trauma, injections, and other inflammatory conditions can contribute.

Fibrous Dysplasia

A noncancerous bone disorder in which normal bone is replaced by weaker abnormal tissue. It may affect one or several bones and cause pain, deformity, fractures, or pressure on nearby nerves.

Fibrous Dysplasia Pathology

A fibro-osseous lesion containing irregular strands of woven bone in a cellular fibrous stroma, classically without prominent osteoblastic rimming. The lesion may be monostotic or polyostotic.

Fibrous Interstitial Pneumonia

A pattern of lung disease in which inflammation and scar tissue thicken the interstitium and impair oxygen transfer. Causes include idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis, autoimmune disease, medication toxicity, and environmental exposure.

Fibrous Joint

A joint in which bones are held together by strong connective tissue and have little or no movement. Skull sutures and syndesmoses are examples.

Fibrous Plaque

A thickened area in an artery wall containing scar-like tissue, cholesterol, and other material. It can narrow blood flow or rupture, allowing a blood clot to form and block the artery.

Alternate Names:
Atherosclerotic Plaque

Fibrous Plaques of the Penis

Fibrous scar-like plaques within the penile tunica albuginea, characteristic of Peyronie disease. They may cause penile curvature, pain during erection, shortening, or difficulty with sexual activity.

Fibrous Sclerosis of the Penis

Another descriptive name for Peyronie disease, a disorder in which fibrous plaques form in the erectile covering and may bend or shorten the penis.

Fibula

The slender bone on the outer side of the lower leg. It provides muscle attachment and forms the outer ankle. The nerve near its upper end can be injured by pressure or fracture.

Fibular Artery

Also called the peroneal artery, it is a branch of the leg's main artery that supplies the outer and back lower leg and contributes blood flow around the ankle.

Fick Principle

A method for estimating blood flow from how much oxygen the body uses and the difference in oxygen content between blood entering and leaving the lungs. It can estimate cardiac output during specialized heart testing.

Alternate Names:
Fick Method; Fick Cardiac Output Determination

Fiducial Markers

Small visible markers placed on or inside the body to identify a precise location during imaging, radiation treatment, or surgery. They help clinicians align equipment and target the intended tissue accurately.

Field Fever

An older name for leptospirosis, a bacterial infection acquired through water or soil contaminated with urine from infected animals. It may cause fever, headache, muscle pain, jaundice, kidney injury, or meningitis.

Field Of View

The area included in a medical image or examination. A wider field shows more of the body, while a narrower field provides greater detail about a smaller area.

Fifth Disease

A usually mild infection caused by parvovirus B19. Children may develop fever, cold-like symptoms, bright-red cheeks, and a lacy rash. It can cause serious fetal anemia during pregnancy and prolonged anemia in some vulnerable people.

Alternate Names:
Erythema Infectiosum; Slapped Cheek Syndrome

FIGO Leiomyoma Classification

A system that describes where a uterine fibroid lies in relation to the uterine cavity and outer surface. The location category helps clinicians predict symptoms and choose treatment.

Filamentous Fungus

A fungus that grows as branching threads called hyphae, which form a network called mycelium. Some filamentous fungi cause skin, nail, lung, or invasive infections, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Filarial Elephantiasis

Long-lasting swelling and thickening of skin and underlying tissues caused by lymphatic blockage from filarial worms. It commonly affects the legs or genitals and may require antiparasitic treatment, skin care, and swelling management.

Filarial Lymphedema

Chronic swelling of a limb, genitalia, or breast caused by lymphatic damage from filarial infection, most often due to *Wuchereria bancrofti* or *Brugia malayi*. Persistent lymphedema can lead to skin thickening and elephantiasis.

Filariasis

Infection with threadlike parasitic worms spread by mosquitoes, flies, or other insects. Depending on the species, worms may affect lymph vessels, skin, or eyes, causing swelling, inflammation, itching, or vision problems.

Filler

A material injected or placed in tissue to restore

volume, smooth wrinkles, change contours, or replace lost structure. Risks include pain, infection, lumps, and accidental blockage of a blood vessel.

Filler Excipient

An inactive ingredient added to a medicine to provide bulk, improve stability, or help form a tablet, capsule, or liquid. It may rarely cause allergy or intolerance.

Filopodium

A thin, finger-like projection from a cell surface. It senses nearby surroundings and helps cells attach, move, communicate, or form connections, including connections made by developing nerve cells.

Filoviridae

A family of viruses that includes Ebola and Marburg viruses. They can cause severe fever, bleeding, organ failure, and death, and are mainly spread through direct contact with blood or other infected body fluids.

Filoviruses

Viruses such as Ebola and Marburg that can cause severe hemorrhagic fever. Symptoms may include fever, headache, muscle pain, vomiting, diarrhea, bleeding, and organ failure; spread occurs through infected body fluids.

Filtered Back Projection

A computer method for creating an image from scan measurements, especially in computed tomography. It is fast, but images may contain more noise or artifacts than those made with newer reconstruction methods.

Filtering Procedure

Eye surgery that creates a new drainage route for fluid to lower pressure inside the eye. It may treat glaucoma when medicines or other procedures do not control pressure adequately.

Filtration

Separation of particles or dissolved substances from a fluid by passing it through a barrier. In the kidneys, tiny filters remove water and small waste products from blood to begin urine formation.

Filtration Fraction

The percentage of plasma flowing through the kidneys that is filtered to begin urine formation. It helps describe kidney blood flow and filtering function and is calculated from kidney filtration compared with plasma flow.

Filum Terminale

A thin strand of connective tissue that anchors the lower end of the spinal cord to the tailbone. Abnormal attachment can restrict cord movement and cause symptoms of tethered spinal cord.

Fimbria

A fringe-like structure. In the fallopian tube, the fimbria are finger-like projections near the ovary that help guide a released egg into the tube; the term is also used for bacterial attachment structures.

Fimbriae

Finger-like projections at the end of each fallopian tube that help collect an egg released from the ovary and guide it into the tube. Their movement and tiny surface hairs help direct the egg toward the uterus.

Fimbriae Proteins

Bacterial surface proteins that form hair-like projections used to attach bacteria to human cells, medical devices, or other surfaces. Attachment can help bacteria form communities and begin infection.

Fine Crackles

Brief, high-pitched, popping sounds heard mainly during breathing in. They may occur when small airways or air sacs open in conditions such as lung scarring, fluid congestion, or other lung disease.

Finegoldia

A group of bacteria that grow without oxygen and normally live on skin or mucous membranes. They

can occasionally cause wound, soft-tissue, bone, joint, or bloodstream infections.

Finegoldia Magna

A bacterium normally found on skin and mucous membranes that grows without oxygen. It can cause infections after wounds or surgery, including abscesses and deeper soft-tissue infections.

Fine Motor Control

The coordinated use of small muscles for accurate movements, especially of the hands and fingers. It supports tasks such as writing, buttoning clothes, using utensils, and handling small objects.

Fine Motor Skills

Abilities that use small muscles for controlled movements, especially in the hands and fingers. Children develop skills such as grasping, feeding themselves, drawing, dressing, and writing at different individual rates.

Fine Needle Aspiration

Alternate spelling; see *Fine-Needle Aspiration*.

Fine-Needle Aspiration

A procedure that uses a thin needle to collect cells or fluid from a lump or organ for laboratory testing. It may be guided by touch or imaging and is usually less invasive than a surgical biopsy.

Alternate Names:
FNA; Fine-Needle Aspiration Cytology; FNAC

Fine Needle Aspiration Of The Thyroid

A procedure using a thin needle, often guided by ultrasound, to collect thyroid cells from a nodule. Laboratory examination helps determine whether the nodule is benign, malignant, or needs further testing.

Finger

One of the hand's digits, made of bones, joints, muscles, tendons, nerves, blood vessels, and skin. Fingers support grasping, touch, balance, and precise movements.

Finger Dislocation

An injury in which the bones of a finger joint are forced out of their normal alignment. Pain, swelling, deformity, and limited movement are common; associated injuries can include fractures, tendon damage, and impaired circulation.

Finger Flexors

Muscles and tendons that bend the fingers at their joints. Injury, especially a cut or forceful injury, can cause pain or inability to bend a finger.

Finger Injury

Damage to a finger's bone, joint, tendon, ligament, nerve, blood vessel, nail, or skin, usually from trauma. Assessment checks alignment, movement, sensation, blood flow, and possible hidden fractures.

Finger Joint

A connection between the bones of a finger that allows bending, straightening, and limited side-to-side movement. Finger joints can be affected by injury, arthritis, inflammation, infection, or dislocation.

Fingernail

The hard protective plate covering the end of a finger, made mainly of keratin and growing from the nail root. Changes in color, shape, or growth can sometimes signal injury or disease.

Finger-Nose Test

A clinical coordination test in which the patient alternately touches their own nose and the examiner's outstretched finger using the index finger. Dysmetria (overshooting or undershooting) or intention tremor during the movement indicates ipsilateral cerebellar hemisphere dysfunction.

Finger Pain

Discomfort in one or more fingers caused by injury, arthritis, tendon problems, nerve compression, infection, inflammation, or reduced blood flow. Sudden severe pain, deformity, numbness, or discoloration may indicate significant injury or impaired circulation.

Fingers That Change Color

Fingers that become white, blue, purple, or red because of changes in blood flow, temperature, or oxygen. Recurrent attacks may be Raynaud phenomenon; persistent changes, pain, numbness, or sores may indicate vascular disease.

Finger Stick

A small fingertip puncture used to collect a drop of capillary blood. The sample can be tested immediately, commonly for blood glucose or other point-of-care measurements.

Finger Sucking

Persistent sucking of a finger or thumb beyond early childhood. Prolonged habit can alter tooth position, the palate, bite, and facial growth; dental assessment may be useful when it persists or causes injury.

Finkelstein Test

A wrist maneuver used to assess for de Quervain tenosynovitis. In the classic test, the examiner holds the thumb and gently moves the hand toward the little finger, stretching tendons on the thumb side of the wrist. Reproduced pain near the radial styloid supports the diagnosis but does not confirm it. The fist-with-thumb-inside variation is Eichhoff's test, though it is often called Finkelstein's.

Alternate Names:
Finkelstein's Test; Finkelstein Sign

Finnish Type Amyloidosis (Type V)

A hereditary gelsolin amyloidosis caused by variants in the *GSN* gene. It commonly causes slowly progressive corneal lattice dystrophy, cranial-nerve weakness, and lax or aging-looking skin, with variable systemic involvement.

Fire Ants

Ants whose stings inject venom and cause immediate burning pain, redness, and itchy pus-filled bumps. Multiple stings can cause severe swelling, vomiting, breathing difficulty, or a life-threatening allergic reaction.

Firesetting Behavior

Deliberately starting fires. Repeated fire-setting may be linked to an impulse-control disorder, mental illness, substance use, developmental problems, or social stress and can involve safety risks to others.

First Adult Seizure

The first suspected seizure in an adult, which may be provoked or unprovoked. Evaluation distinguishes seizure from mimics such as syncope and considers immediate causes, recurrence risk, injury, medicines, and substances.

First Aid

Immediate assistance given for injury or sudden illness before definitive medical care. It may include scene safety, emergency activation, basic life support, and measures to limit bleeding or further injury.

First Aid for Burns

Initial care for a burn before definitive treatment, including cooling a thermal burn with cool running water and protecting the injured area with a clean covering. Ice, tight dressings, and breaking blisters can worsen tissue injury; deep, extensive, chemical, electrical, or airway burns may require emergency treatment.

First Aid Kit

A group of supplies for treating minor injuries and giving temporary care during emergencies. Useful items include gloves, dressings, bandages, antiseptic, scissors, and emergency contact information.

First-Degree Atrioventricular Block

Alternate name; see *First-Degree AV Block*.

First-Degree AV Block

A mild delay in the electrical signal traveling from the heart's upper chambers to its lower chambers. Every signal still reaches the lower chambers; it is often symptomless but may reflect medicines or heart disease.

First-Degree Burn

A superficial burn affecting only the outer skin layer. It causes redness, pain, and dryness without blisters, as with mild sunburn, and usually heals within several days without scarring.

First-Degree Heart Block

Alternate name; see *First-Degree AV Block*.

First-Episode Psychosis

The first recognized period of losing contact with reality, such as hearing or seeing things that are not present or holding fixed false beliefs. Causes include medical, medication, substance, and psychiatric conditions.

First Menstrual Period

Menarche, the first menstrual bleeding, usually occurring during puberty. Its timing varies with development, health, and other individual factors; unusually early or delayed onset may reflect an underlying condition.

First-Pass Effect

Alternate name; see *First-Pass Metabolism*.

First-Pass Metabolism

Breakdown of a swallowed medicine by the intestinal wall and liver before it enters general circulation. Extensive breakdown lowers the active amount reaching the body and can influence dose or route of administration.

First Stage Of Labor

The time from regular labor contractions that cause cervical change until the cervix is fully open. It includes early and active phases, with progress varying according to the person, fetus, and clinical circumstances.

First Trimester

The first part of pregnancy, extending from the first day of the last menstrual period through 13 weeks and 6 days of gestation in standard obstetric dating. It includes embryonic development and early fetal growth.

Fisher's Syndrome

A rare nerve disorder, usually after an infection, causing eye-muscle weakness, poor coordination, and reduced or absent reflexes. It is a variant of Guillain-Barré syndrome.

Fisher Syndrome

An acute autoimmune variant of Guillain-Barré syndrome characterized by the classic clinical triad of acute ophthalmoplegia, ataxia, and areflexia, strongly associated with anti-GQ1b IgG ganglioside antibodies following an upper respiratory or gastrointestinal infection.

Alternate Names:
Miller Fisher Syndrome; MFS

Fish-Handler's Disease

A skin infection caused by Erysipelothrix bacteria after handling infected fish, shellfish, meat, or animals. It usually causes a slowly expanding, painful purple-red lesion on the hand or fingers.

Fishhook Removal

Removal of a fishhook from skin or deeper tissue. The method depends on the hook's location and depth; clinicians assess nerves, blood vessels, tendons, joints, tetanus protection, and infection risk.

Fish Odour Syndrome

A rare metabolic disorder in which trimethylamine builds up and causes a fish-like smell in sweat, breath, or urine. Symptoms may vary with diet; testing, dietary guidance, and emotional support can help.

Fish Oil

Oil containing omega-3 fatty acids, usually obtained from oily fish. Supplements may lower triglycerides at therapeutic doses, but benefits vary and adverse effects or medicine interactions can occur.

Fish Poisoning

Illness caused by toxins or germs in contaminated

or improperly stored fish. Symptoms may include vomiting, diarrhea, flushing, tingling, weakness, or breathing difficulty; severe illness can be life-threatening.

Fish Tank Granuloma

A chronic localized cutaneous mycobacterial infection caused by Mycobacterium marinum, contracted through contact of broken skin with non-chlorinated aquarium water or infected fish. It presents as persistent red-to-violaceous papules, nodules, or ulcers typically on the hands or fingers, occasionally ascending along lymphatic channels in a sporotrichoid pattern.

Alternate Names:
Aquarium Granuloma; Swimming Pool Granuloma

Fish Tapeworm Infection

An intestinal infection acquired by eating raw or undercooked fish containing tapeworm larvae. It may cause abdominal discomfort, diarrhea, weight loss, or vitamin B12 deficiency and is usually treatable with antiparasitic medicine.

Fish Venom

Poison produced by certain fish, usually delivered through spines or sharp body parts. It can cause immediate severe pain, swelling, numbness, tissue injury, or rarely whole-body poisoning.

Fissure

A narrow crack, groove, or split in a body structure. An anal fissure is a painful tear in the anal lining, often causing sharp pain and bright-red bleeding during bowel movements.

Fissured Tongue

A usually harmless condition in which grooves develop on the tongue's surface. Food debris may collect in the grooves and sometimes cause irritation or odor.

Fistula

An abnormal passage between two body parts, such as two organs, a blood vessel and another structure, or an organ and the skin. It may result from infection, inflammation, injury, surgery, or cancer. Symptoms and treatment depend on its location; some close with medical treatment, while others need a procedure or surgery.

Alternate Names:
Pathologic Fistula; Fistulous Tract; Abnormal Organ Tunnel

Fistula-In-Ano

Alternate term; see *Anal Fistula*.

Fistulotomy

Surgery that opens an anal fistula, an abnormal tunnel between the anal canal and nearby skin, so it can heal from the inside out. It is mainly used for simple fistulas. More complex fistulas may need another treatment to protect bowel control.

Alternate Names:
Anal Fistulotomy; Fistula-in-Ano Surgery; Laying Open of Fistula

Fit

A seizure or sudden episode of altered movement or awareness; this everyday term is also used to mean physically healthy. In medical writing, it can be ambiguous because it has these distinct meanings.

Fitz Hugh Curtis Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Fitz-Hugh-Curtis Syndrome*.

Fitz-Hugh-Curtis Syndrome

Inflammation and scarring around the liver caused by pelvic inflammatory disease, usually from gonorrhea or chlamydia. It can cause sharp right-upper-abdominal pain, fever, and pain that worsens with movement or breathing.

Five-Alpha Reductase

An enzyme that changes testosterone into dihydrotestosterone (DHT). DHT supports male sexual development and contributes to prostate growth and male-pattern hair loss. Medicines that block this enzyme are used for an enlarged prostate and some types of hair loss.

Alternate Names:

5-Alpha Reductase; 5-α-Reductase; Steroid 5-Alpha Reductase

Five-Year Survival Rate

The percentage of people alive five years after a diagnosis or treatment. It summarizes outcomes for groups, not an individual's exact prognosis, which also depends on cancer type, stage, health, and treatment.

Fixation

Holding a body part, tissue, or broken bone in the correct position while it heals. Methods include stitches, wires, screws, plates, rods, casts, splints, or external frames.

Fixative

A chemical used to preserve cells or tissue for laboratory examination by preventing decay and maintaining structure. Common fixatives can irritate skin, eyes, and airways; handling involves appropriate ventilation and protective equipment.

Fixator Muscle

A muscle that holds one part of the body steady while another part moves.

Fixed Drug Eruptions

Recurrent sharply demarcated red or dusky patches caused by a medicine, often at the same sites each time exposure occurs. Lesions may blister or ulcerate and leave persistent dark pigmentation; stopping the culprit drug prevents recurrence.

Fixed Joint

A joint that permits little or no movement because the bones are joined by bone or dense connective tissue. Some fixed joints are normal; others result from injury, disease, or surgical fusion.

Alternate Names:
Synarthrosis; Immovable Joint

Fixed Macrophage

An immune cell that stays within a particular tissue instead of circulating in blood. It removes dead cells and microbes and helps coordinate inflammation and repair.

Flaccid

Soft and lacking normal firmness or muscle tone. It may describe a limb, muscle, bladder, or penis; sudden flaccid weakness, especially on one side, can signal a neurologic emergency.

Flagellin

The main protein in a bacterial flagellum, the whip-like structure that helps some bacteria move. Human immune cells can recognize flagellin and respond with inflammation.

Flagellum

A long, whip-like structure that helps a cell or microorganism move. Human sperm and some bacteria have flagella, which differ in structure and function.

Flail Chest

A serious chest injury in which several ribs break in more than one place, leaving part of the chest wall unstable. Severe pain and difficult breathing can result, often with lung bruising.

Flakka

A street name for illicit synthetic stimulant drugs, especially alpha-PVP. Overdose can cause extreme agitation, hallucinations, seizures, dangerously high temperature, muscle breakdown, irregular heartbeat, or death and requires emergency treatment.

Flanged Needle

A needle with a widened rim or attached flange that helps stabilize it, limit how far it enters, or connect it to another device. The flange may reduce movement and tissue injury during sampling, injection, drainage, or infusion.

Flank

The side of the body between the lower ribs and the hip, including part of the abdomen and back. Pain in this area may arise from the kidney, muscles, spine, bowel, or nearby organs.

Flank Pain

Pain between the lower ribs and hip, often caused by kidney stones, kidney infection, muscle strain, spine problems, or nearby abdominal disease. Fever, vomiting, blood in urine, injury, or severe pain may accompany serious causes.

Flap Operation

Surgery that moves a piece of skin, tissue, or muscle, while preserving its blood supply, to cover a wound or reconstruct a damaged body part. Risks include infection, bleeding, and loss of the flap.

Flapping Tremor

An involuntary, irregular jerky movement (asterixis) characterized by brief, sudden lapses of posture in the dorsiflexed hands when the arms are held extended with the wrists hyperextended, characteristic of hepatic encephalopathy, uremic encephalopathy, and severe hypercapnia.

Alternate Names:
Asterixis; Liver Flap

Flare

A temporary increase in symptoms or inflammation after a disease has been stable or less active. Flares may be triggered by infection, stress, injury, or treatment changes; symptoms can be severe or unusual.

Alternate Names:
Exacerbation; Disease Flare-Up

Flare-Up

A sudden or gradual worsening of a long-term disease after a period of relative stability. The cause may be infection, stress, missed treatment, or disease progression; symptoms may be severe or persistent.

Flashes

Brief flickers or streaks of light seen without an outside light source. They may result from changes in the eye's gel, migraine, or inflammation; sudden flashes with floaters or missing vision can indicate a retinal tear or detachment.

Flashing

Seeing brief flashes or streaks of light without an external source. New flashing, especially with floaters, a curtain-like shadow, eye pain, or reduced vision, can indicate a retinal emergency.

Flat Affect

Very little outward expression of emotion, such as reduced facial movement, gestures, or voice variation. It is a clinical sign, not a diagnosis, and may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, or medication-related conditions.

Flat Epithelial Atypia

A change in the cells lining small breast ducts, in which the cells look mildly abnormal and form a flat layer. It is usually found in a tissue sample taken after breast imaging. It is not cancer, but may occur alongside a more serious nearby change.

Flat Bones

Broad, relatively thin bones such as the skull, ribs, breastbone, and shoulder blades. They protect organs, provide surfaces for muscle attachment, and contain marrow that produces blood cells.

Flat Feet

Alternate name; see *Fallen Arches*.

Flatfoot

Alternate name; see *Fallen Arches*.

Flatfoot (Pes Planus)

Alternate name; see *Fallen Arches*.

Flatulence

Passage of gas through the anus, produced by swallowed air and bacterial digestion of food in the intestine. It may increase with diet, constipation, swallowing air, or digestive disorders.

Flatus

Gas released through the anus after air is swallowed or intestinal bacteria break down food. Passing gas is normal; inability to pass gas with increasing

abdominal swelling, vomiting, or pain may indicate bowel obstruction.

Alternate Names:
Intestinal Gas; Expelled Gas

Flatus and Bloating

Passing gas through the anus (flatus) and a feeling of abdominal fullness or swelling (bloating). Gas can contribute to bloating, but the two are distinct symptoms and bloating may occur without excess intestinal gas.

Flavin Adenine Dinucleotide

A helper molecule made from vitamin B2 that allows enzymes to transfer electrons during energy production and other chemical reactions. It is commonly abbreviated FAD.

Alternate Names:
FAD; Riboflavin Dinucleotide

Flaviviridae

A family of single-stranded RNA viruses that includes dengue, yellow fever, Zika, hepatitis C, and West Nile viruses. Different members spread through insects, blood, or other routes and cause different illnesses.

Flavivirus

A group of viruses primarily spread to humans through the bites of infected mosquitoes or ticks. Notable members of this virus family include the dengue virus, yellow fever virus, Zika virus, West Nile virus, and Japanese encephalitis virus. Infections can range from mild flu-like symptoms to severe hemorrhagic fevers or neurological brain infections (encephalitis).

Alternate Names:
Flaviviruses; Flaviviridae

Flaviviruses

Plural form; see *Flavivirus*.

Flavobacteriaceae

A family of mainly gram-negative bacteria found in water, soil, and other environments. Most do not infect people, but some can cause opportunistic infections, especially in hospitalized or immunocompromised patients.

Flavobacterium

A group of gram-negative bacteria commonly found in water and soil. A few species can cause opportunistic infections in people or animals, particularly when immunity is weakened.

Flavoxate

A medicine used to relieve bladder spasms, urgency, frequency, or painful urination. It treats symptoms rather than infection or blockage and can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, dizziness, or constipation.

Flaxseed Extract

A preparation made from flaxseed that may contain omega-3 fat, lignans, and soluble fiber. Effects vary by product; it may interact with medicines affecting clotting, blood sugar, or blood pressure.

Flea

A small, wingless, laterally compressed, hematophagous ectoparasitic insect belonging to the order Siphonaptera. Possessing specialized piercing-sucking mouthparts and elongated hind legs adapted for jumping onto animal and human hosts, fleas feed on blood and produce pruritic, papular urticarial dermatological eruptions. Clinically significant species include the human flea (*Pulex irritans*), the oriental rat flea (*Xenopsylla cheopis*, the primary vector of bubonic plague caused by *Yersinia pestis* and murine typhus caused by *Rickettsia typhi*), the cat flea (*Ctenocephalides felis*, vector of cat-scratch disease caused by *Bartonella henselae*), and the chigoe flea (*Tunga penetrans*, which burrows into skin causing tungiasis).

Alternate Names:
Fleas; Siphonaptera

Flea Bites

Itchy red bumps caused by fleas feeding on the skin, often clustered around the ankles or lower legs. Scratching can cause infection; treating pets and

the environment helps prevent new bites.

Flea Bites In Humans

Small itchy bumps, often around the ankles or lower legs, caused by flea feeding. Allergic reactions may produce larger areas of swelling; control requires treating infested animals, bedding, rooms, and symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Pulicosis; Flea-Borne Dermatitis

Fleas

Plural form; see *Flea*.

Flecainide

A prescription antiarrhythmic medicine that slows electrical signals in the heart to prevent selected abnormal rhythms. It is not suitable for everyone and can worsen dangerous rhythms, especially with structural heart disease.

Fleischner Sign

A chest radiographic sign of acute pulmonary embolism consisting of a prominent, enlarged central pulmonary artery terminating abruptly, caused by distension of the vessel by a large impacted thromboembolus and downstream vasoconstriction.

Alternate Names:
Fleischner's Sign; Dilated Central Pulmonary Artery Sign

Flesh-Eating Bacteria

Informal name for bacteria that can cause necrotizing fasciitis, a rapidly progressive deep soft-tissue infection. Severe pain, swelling, fever, skin discoloration, blisters, or serious illness requires emergency treatment.

Flesh-Eating Bug

An informal name for necrotizing fasciitis, a rapidly spreading infection of deep skin and soft tissue. Severe pain out of proportion to visible changes, swelling, fever, blisters, or skin discoloration requires emergency care.

Flex

To bend a joint so the angle between connected bones becomes smaller. For example, bending the elbow brings the forearm toward the upper arm; pain, swelling, stiffness, or weakness can limit this movement.

Alternate Names:
Flexion; Joint Bending

Flexed Breech

Alternate name; see *Complete Breech*.

Flexibility

The range of movement available at a joint or group of joints. It depends on bones, muscles, tendons, ligaments, joint health, nervous-system control, age, training, and pain.

Flexible Nasolaryngoscopy

An examination using a thin flexible camera passed through the nose to view the nasal passages, throat, and voice box. It helps investigate hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, blockage, lesions, and vocal-cord movement.

Flexible Sigmoidoscopy

An examination using a flexible camera to view the rectum and lower colon. It can investigate bleeding, diarrhea, or bowel symptoms and monitor known disease; preparation and biopsy may be needed.

Flexion

Movement that bends a joint and decreases the angle between connected bones, such as bending the elbow, knee, hip, or fingers.

Flexor

A muscle or tendon that bends a joint or body part. Flexors in the arm and hand bend the fingers and wrist; injury can cause pain, weakness, or loss of movement.

Flexor Digitorum Profundus

A deep forearm muscle whose tendons bend the end joints of the fingers and also assist wrist movement.

Its inner part is supplied by the ulnar nerve and its outer part by the median nerve.

Flexor Digitorum Superficialis

A forearm muscle whose tendons bend the middle joints of the fingers and assist wrist movement. Damage to the muscle, tendon, or median nerve can cause pain and difficulty bending the fingers.

Flexor Hallucis Longus Tendinitis

Irritation or inflammation of the tendon that bends the big toe. It passes behind the inner ankle and under the foot, so pain may occur there or beneath the big toe, especially during push-off when walking or running.

Flexor Tendon Anatomy

The arrangement and function of the tendons that bend the fingers, thumb, and wrist. Flexor tendons pass from forearm muscles through the wrist and hand in defined zones and sheaths; injury can impair finger flexion and involve nerves or blood vessels.

Flexor Tenosynovitis

A serious infection around a tendon that bends a finger, often after a cut or puncture. The finger may become swollen, stay partly bent, and hurt when straightened; infection can damage the tendon and surrounding tissues.

Alternate Names:
Suppurative Tenosynovitis; Kanavel Tenosynovitis

Flexural

Relating to a skin fold or the inner surface of a bent joint, such as the elbow crease, back of the knee, armpit, groin, or fold beneath the breast.

Flibanserin

A prescription medicine for persistent, distressing low sexual desire in some premenopausal women. It is taken regularly rather than as needed and can cause dizziness, sleepiness, low blood pressure, or fainting, especially with alcohol.

Flight-Or-Fight Response

The body's rapid response to perceived danger, releasing stress hormones that increase heart rate, breathing, alertness, and muscle readiness so a person can escape or confront a threat.

Alternate Names:
Sympathoadrenal Response

Floater

Alternate name; see *Floaters*.

Floaters

Moving spots, threads, cobwebs, or rings in the field of vision caused by shadows from material in the eye's vitreous gel. They are often age-related, but sudden onset can indicate bleeding or a retinal tear.

Floating Kidney

Unusual downward movement of a kidney when a person stands, sometimes called nephroptosis. It is often symptomless but may cause position-related flank pain, urinary symptoms, or rarely impaired urine drainage.

Floating Rib

One of the two lowest pairs of ribs (the eleventh and twelfth ribs) on each side of the rib cage. Unlike the other ribs, which connect either directly or indirectly to the breastbone (sternum) via cartilage, floating ribs are attached only to the spine in the back, leaving their front ends free in the muscle wall of the lower abdomen.

Alternate Names:
Floating Ribs; Costa Fluctuans

Floating Ribs

Plural form; see *Floating Rib*.

Flocculation

The joining of tiny particles suspended in a liquid into larger clumps. Laboratory tests may use this visible reaction to detect antibodies or other substances; it is also used in water treatment and pharmaceutical preparation.

Floor Of The Mouth Cancer

Cancer arising in the tissues beneath the tongue, most often from surface cells. It may cause a persistent ulcer, lump, pain, bleeding, numbness, or difficulty swallowing or speaking.

Alternate Names:
Oral Floor Squamous Cell Carcinoma; Sublingual Malignancy

Floppy Baby Syndrome

An informal description of an infant with unusually low muscle tone and a limp posture. Causes include brain, spinal cord, nerve, muscle, genetic, or metabolic disorders.

Floppy Eyelid Syndrome

A disorder in which the upper eyelid is unusually lax and easily turns inside out, with chronic papillary conjunctivitis (inflammation of the inner eyelid). The eyelid may turn outward during sleep, exposing and irritating the eye and causing redness, tearing, discharge, or a gritty feeling, often worse on waking. The syndrome is associated with obstructive sleep apnea and keratoconus.

Floppy Iris Syndrome

A cataract-surgery complication in which the iris becomes unusually loose, moves with fluid currents, and narrows the working space. It is associated with some prostate medicines.

Floppy Valve Syndrome

A condition in which the mitral valve's leaflets bulge backward into the upper heart chamber when the heart contracts. It is often harmless but may cause palpitations, chest discomfort, or leakage through the valve.

Alternate Names:
Mitral Valve Prolapse; Barlow Syndrome

Flora

The microorganisms living normally or temporarily in a body site or environment. Some protect against harmful organisms, but they can cause infection if they enter another body site or defenses are weakened.

Flossing

Cleaning between teeth with dental floss or another interdental device to remove plaque and food that a toothbrush cannot reach. Gentle daily cleaning can help prevent gum disease and cavities.

Flotation

A laboratory method that separates material by density. For example, a flotation test can concentrate parasite eggs from stool so they are easier to identify under a microscope.

Flow Cytometry

A laboratory test that examines cells or particles one at a time as they pass through a laser beam. It can count cells and identify their features, helping diagnose blood cancers and immune disorders.

Flowmeter

A device that measures the rate at which a gas or liquid moves. In medicine, it may measure oxygen delivery, intravenous fluid flow, or breathing flow such as peak expiratory flow.

Flow-Volume Loop

A graph showing how much air moves in and out of the lungs at different speeds during forceful breathing. Its shape can help identify airway narrowing, reduced lung size, or an upper-airway blockage.

Floxacillin

An antibacterial medicine used in some countries to treat infections caused by susceptible bacteria, especially staphylococci. It can cause allergic reactions, diarrhea, liver problems, or other antibiotic-related effects.

Floxuridine

An anticancer medicine that interferes with DNA production, slowing or killing rapidly dividing cells. It is used only in selected treatment plans and may cause low blood counts, mouth sores, diarrhea, or other toxicity.

Flu

An acute respiratory infection caused by influenza viruses. It commonly causes sudden fever, cough, sore throat, headache, muscle aches, and fatigue and can lead to pneumonia or worsen chronic diseases.

Flucloxacillin

An antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections, especially those caused by susceptible staphylococci. Adverse effects include nausea, diarrhea, allergy, and liver injury.

Fluconazole

An antifungal medicine used for selected yeast and other fungal infections. It can interact with many medicines and may cause nausea, rash, or liver injury; treatment depends on the infection and patient.

Flucytosine

An antifungal medicine converted inside susceptible fungi into substances that interfere with genetic-material production. It is used for selected serious infections, usually with another antifungal, and requires blood-count and liver monitoring.

Fludarabine

A chemotherapy medicine that interferes with DNA production in abnormal blood cells. It treats selected blood cancers but can severely suppress immunity and blood counts, increasing the risk of serious infections.

Fludarabine Phosphate

A form of fludarabine used in selected blood-cancer treatment plans. It interferes with DNA production and can cause prolonged low blood counts, immune suppression, infections, and neurologic or other serious effects.

Fludeoxyglucose F-18

A radioactive form of glucose used in positron-emission tomography scans. Active tissues absorb more of it, helping doctors assess some cancers, brain disorders, and heart muscle; uptake is not specific for cancer.

Fludrocortisone

A medicine that helps the body retain salt and water and raise blood pressure. It treats some adrenal-hormone deficiencies and selected orthostatic disorders; monitoring is needed for swelling, high blood pressure, and low potassium.

Fluid Around The Heart

Extra fluid in the sac surrounding the heart. Small amounts may cause no symptoms, while rapid or large collections can restrict heart filling and cause breathlessness, low blood pressure, or life-threatening tamponade.

Alternate Names:
Pericardial Effusion; Hydropericardium

Fluid Balance

The relationship between water entering and leaving the body. The kidneys, hormones, thirst, breathing, sweat, and stool help regulate it; disruption can cause dehydration, swelling, or abnormal blood salts.

Fluid Imbalance

Too much or too little body water or an abnormal level of salts such as sodium or potassium. Causes include vomiting, diarrhea, kidney or heart disease, hormone disorders, dehydration, or excess fluid treatment.

Fluid in Lungs

An informal phrase that can refer to two different findings: pulmonary edema, fluid in the lung's tissue or air sacs, or pleural effusion, fluid in the space around the lung. The medical term should identify which location is involved.

Fluid Management

Planning and monitoring fluids, salts, and urine output to maintain circulation and organ function. Treatment may involve drinking, intravenous fluids, diuretics, or fluid restriction according to the underlying problem.

Fluid Overload

Excess water and salt in the body, causing swelling, rapid weight gain, high blood pressure, or fluid in the lungs. It may result from heart, kidney, or liver disease or too much fluid treatment.

Fluid Therapy

Treatment using fluids, by mouth or through a vein, to restore hydration, blood volume, or salt balance. The type and amount depend on the cause; excess fluid can worsen swelling, heart failure, or lung congestion.

Fluid Wave

A physical test for fluid buildup in the belly (ascites); tapping one side of the stomach causes a ripple or wave that can be felt with the other hand on the opposite side.

Flu (Influenza)

Alternate name; see *Flu*.

Alternate Names:
Influenza; Grippe; Viral Flu

Fluke

A flat, leaf-shaped parasitic worm. Different species infect the liver, lungs, intestines, or blood vessels and are acquired through contaminated food, water, or contact with freshwater.

Flumazenil

An antidote that can reverse sedation and slowed breathing caused by some benzodiazepine medicines. It can trigger seizures or sudden withdrawal and is not suitable for every overdose, especially mixed overdoses.

Flunarizine

A medicine used in some countries to prevent migraine and treat selected balance disorders. Adverse effects include sleepiness, weight gain, depression, or movement problems.

Flunisolide

An inhaled or nasal corticosteroid used to reduce inflammation in asthma or allergic rhinitis. It may cause throat irritation, nosebleeds, or oral thrush; regular use does not relieve a sudden severe asthma attack.

Fluocinolone

A corticosteroid applied to skin, scalp, or other affected areas to reduce inflammation and itching. Prolonged or extensive use can thin the skin or rarely cause effects throughout the body.

Fluocinolone Acetonide

A corticosteroid medicine applied to the skin or scalp to reduce redness, swelling, and itching. Overuse can thin the skin, worsen infections, or rarely affect the body's hormone system.

Fluocinonide

A strong corticosteroid applied to selected inflammatory skin conditions to reduce itching, redness, and swelling. Prolonged or extensive use can damage skin or cause systemic effects.

Fluocortolone

A corticosteroid used in selected skin or other inflammatory conditions. It reduces inflammation but can cause skin thinning, infection, or other steroid effects, especially when used for a long time or over large areas.

Fluorescein

A bright fluorescent dye used in eye examinations and some imaging tests. In the eye, it highlights scratches, ulcers, and abnormal blood-vessel leakage; rare allergic reactions can occur after injection.

Fluorescein Angiography

An eye test in which fluorescent dye is injected into a vein and photographs track its movement through retinal blood vessels. It can show leakage, blockage, or abnormal vessels in retinal disease.

Fluorescein Eye Stain

A test in which dye is placed on the eye and viewed under blue light. It highlights scratches, ulcers,

foreign-body injuries, and some dry-eye surface damage.

Fluorescence

The emission of visible light by a substance after it absorbs light or other energy. Clinicians and researchers use it to identify cells, chemicals, microbes, or structures in laboratory and imaging tests.

Fluorescence In Situ Hybridization

A laboratory test that uses glowing DNA probes to find specific chromosome regions or gene changes in cells. It can detect selected missing, extra, rearranged, or amplified genetic material.

Alternate Names:
FISH; Molecular Cytogenetic Assay

Fluorescence Microscopy

A microscope method that uses fluorescent labels to make selected cells, molecules, or microbes visible. It helps examine tissue structure, cell proteins, genetic material, and infectious organisms.

Fluorescent Dye

A substance that absorbs light of one color and emits light of another. It can label cells, tissues, molecules, or microbes so they can be detected during laboratory or imaging examinations.

Fluoridation

Adding a controlled amount of fluoride to water or dental products to strengthen tooth enamel and reduce cavities. Excessive fluoride during tooth development can cause dental fluorosis, which appears as enamel discoloration or pits.

Fluoride

A mineral that strengthens tooth enamel, helps repair early damage, and reduces acid production by cavity-causing bacteria. It is found in some water supplies, toothpaste, mouth rinses, and professional dental treatments.

Fluoride In Diet

Fluoride obtained from drinking water and foods or drinks made with fluoridated water. The right amount helps protect teeth, while excessive intake, especially in children, can damage developing enamel.

Fluoride Overdose

Excessive fluoride swallowed over a short time. It can cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, low blood calcium, muscle spasms, abnormal heart rhythms, or seizures; severe poisoning can be life-threatening.

Fluoride Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing too much fluoride. Early symptoms include nausea, vomiting, and abdominal pain; severe poisoning can lower blood calcium and cause muscle spasms, seizures, or dangerous heart rhythms.

Fluoride Toxicity

Alternate term; see *Fluoride Poisoning*.

Fluoride Varnish

A concentrated fluoride coating painted onto teeth by a dental professional to prevent or slow cavities. It hardens quickly and is used at intervals based on age, tooth condition, and cavity risk.

Fluorimetry

A laboratory method that measures light emitted by a fluorescent substance. It can detect or estimate very small amounts of chemicals, medicines, proteins, or biological material.

Fluorine

A highly reactive chemical element found in compounds such as fluoride. Small controlled amounts of fluoride help protect teeth, while excessive exposure can poison the body or damage developing bones and teeth.

Fluorine-18

A radioactive form of fluorine used to label tracers for positron-emission tomography scans. Its short half-life allows useful imaging while limiting how

long radioactivity remains in the body.

Fluorometholone

A corticosteroid eye medicine used for selected inflammatory conditions. Prolonged use can raise eye pressure, delay healing, worsen infection, or increase cataract risk, so it requires medical supervision.

Fluorophotometry

A method that measures fluorescent light from the eye or another sample. It can help estimate substances or tissue properties; results depend on the test method and clinical findings.

Fluoropyrimidine

A class of anticancer medicines that resembles substances used to build DNA and RNA. They disrupt genetic-material production in rapidly dividing cells and can cause mouth sores, diarrhea, low blood counts, and hand-foot symptoms.

Fluoroquinolone

A class of synthetic, broad-spectrum, bactericidal antimicrobial agents (e.g., ciprofloxacin, levofloxacin, moxifloxacin, delafloxacin) that directly inhibit bacterial DNA replication, transcription, and repair by targeting bacterial type II topoisomerases: DNA gyrase (primarily in gram-negative bacteria) and topoisomerase IV (primarily in gram-positive bacteria). Classified into generations with progressively expanded atypical and respiratory gram-positive coverage. Although highly effective for complicated urinary tract infections, severe intra-abdominal infections, and selected hospital-acquired pneumonias, clinical utilization is strictly regulated due to significant class-wide black-box toxicities, including tendinitis and tendon rupture (most commonly the Achilles tendon), peripheral neuropathy, central nervous system toxicities, QT-interval prolongation predisposing to torsades de pointes, dysglycemia, and an elevated risk of aortic aneurysm and dissection.

Alternate Names:
Fluoroquinolones; Quinolones

Fluoroquinolone-Associated Disability

A term used for disabling, sometimes long-lasting adverse effects associated with fluoroquinolone antibiotics. Reported effects may involve tendons, muscles, joints, peripheral nerves, the central nervous system, or other organs and may occur together; it is not a formally established single diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
FQAD

Fluoroquinolones

Plural form; see *Fluoroquinolone*.

Fluoroscopy

An X-ray method that produces moving images inside the body. It helps guide procedures and examine swallowing, blood vessels, joints, and digestive or urinary passages; contrast dye may be used and radiation exposure occurs.

Fluorosis

A change in developing tooth enamel caused by too much fluoride during childhood. It usually appears as white streaks or spots; more severe cases cause brown discoloration or pits.

Fluorouracil

An anticancer medicine that interferes with DNA production. It is applied to selected precancerous skin lesions or given for some cancers; possible effects include mouth sores, diarrhea, low blood counts, and serious toxicity in susceptible people.

Fluorouracil Side Effect

An unwanted effect of fluorouracil, such as mouth sores, diarrhea, nausea, low blood counts, hand-foot skin reactions, or heart problems. Severe toxicity may lead to treatment interruption or dose adjustment.

Fluoxetine

An antidepressant that increases available serotonin in the brain. It treats depression and several other conditions, but may cause nausea, sleep or sexual problems, agitation, or rarely dangerous serotonin

excess or suicidal thoughts.

Fluoxymesterone

A synthetic androgen medicine used in selected hormone-related conditions. Potential effects include liver injury, altered cholesterol, mood changes, reduced fertility, prostate effects, and changes in blood count.

Flupentixol

An antipsychotic medicine used in some countries for schizophrenia and other psychiatric conditions. It can reduce hallucinations and delusions but may cause movement problems, sleepiness, hormonal changes, or rare serious reactions.

Fluphenazine

An antipsychotic medicine used to treat schizophrenia and related psychotic symptoms. It can cause stiffness, tremor, restlessness, sleepiness, hormonal changes, and rare but serious involuntary movements or fever.

Fluphenazine Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride salt form of fluphenazine, an antipsychotic medicine for selected psychotic disorders. Monitoring is needed because it can cause movement disorders, sedation, hormonal effects, and other serious adverse reactions.

Flurandrenolide

A corticosteroid applied to the skin to reduce inflammation, redness, and itching. Prolonged, extensive, or covered use can thin the skin, worsen infection, or allow steroid effects throughout the body.

Flurazepam

A long-acting sedative medicine used for short-term treatment of insomnia in some settings. It can cause next-day drowsiness, falls, memory problems, dependence, and dangerous breathing suppression with alcohol or opioids.

Flurbiprofen

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and swelling and, in some forms, eye inflammation. Adverse effects include stomach bleeding, kidney problems, cardiovascular events, and allergic reactions.

Flush

A sudden feeling of warmth or visible reddening caused by increased skin blood flow. In healthcare, flush can also mean washing a tube, body passage, or intravenous line with fluid.

Flushable Reagent Stool Blood Test

Alternate name; see *Fecal Occult Blood Test*.

Flushing

Temporary redness and warmth of the skin caused by increased blood flow. Triggers include heat, exercise, emotion, alcohol, medicines, fever, or hormone disorders; flushing with wheezing, diarrhea, faintness, or palpitations needs evaluation.

Flutamide

A medicine that blocks male-hormone effects and is used with other hormone treatment for prostate cancer. It can seriously injure the liver and may cause nausea, breast tenderness, or reduced blood counts.

Flutter

A rapid, regular, repetitive movement or contraction. Atrial flutter is an abnormal heart rhythm caused by a fast electrical circuit in the upper chambers and can increase the risk of stroke.

Flutter Valve

A handheld breathing device that creates gentle pressure and vibrations during exhalation. It can help loosen and move mucus in some people with bronchiectasis, cystic fibrosis, or chronic lung disease.

Fluvastatin

A statin medicine that lowers low-density lipoprotein cholesterol by reducing cholesterol production in the liver. It lowers cardiovascular risk but can

cause muscle symptoms, liver abnormalities, or rare muscle breakdown.

Fluvoxamine

An antidepressant that increases serotonin signaling and is used mainly for obsessive-compulsive disorder and selected other conditions. It can cause nausea, sleep changes, sexual problems, medicine interactions, or rarely serotonin toxicity.

Flux

An old, nonspecific term for diarrhea or an excessive discharge, especially from the bowel. Modern descriptions usually specify the symptom, duration, severity, and suspected cause.

FM

Abbreviation for fibromyalgia; see *Fibromyalgia*.

FMRI

Functional magnetic resonance imaging maps changes in brain blood flow and oxygen use while a person performs tasks or rests. It can help identify language or movement areas and does not use X-ray radiation.

FMS

Abbreviation sometimes used for fibromyalgia syndrome; see *Fibromyalgia*. The abbreviation can have other meanings.

FNA

An abbreviation for fine-needle aspiration, a procedure using a thin needle to collect cells or fluid from a lump or organ for laboratory examination. The full term is clearer in patient information.

FND

Abbreviation; see *Functional Neurologic Disorder*.

Foam Cell

A lipid-laden macrophage (or modified vascular smooth muscle cell) characterized histologically by a vacuolated, pale, "foamy" cytoplasm filled with accumulated cholesteryl esters and lipid droplets. Forms during early atherogenesis when circulating monocytes adhere to injured vascular endothelium, migrate into the subendothelial intima, and differentiate into macrophages. Macrophages express cell-surface scavenger receptors (such as CD36 and SR-A) that internalize oxidized low-density lipoproteins (oxLDL) in an unregulated manner, escaping normal negative feedback cholesterol regulation. The progressive accumulation of foam cells produces the earliest visible lesion of atherosclerosis, the "fatty streak." Over time, foam cells undergo apoptotic and necrotic cell death, releasing their lipid cargo into the extracellular space to form the necrotic, prothrombotic core of mature atheromatous plaques.

Alternate Names:
Foam Cells; Lipid-Laden Macrophage

Foam Cells

Plural form; see *Foam Cell*.

Focal

Limited to one specific area rather than spread widely. A focal finding may involve an image, seizure, infection, injury, or neurologic problem; its location helps define its significance.

Focal Adhesion

A specialized attachment site where a cell connects to its surrounding support material. It helps cells stick, sense physical forces, move, and send signals during growth and tissue repair.

Focal Aware Seizures

Seizures arising from a localized brain network in which awareness is preserved during the event. Symptoms may be motor, sensory, autonomic, cognitive, emotional, or experiential.

Focal Cortical Dysplasia

A spectrum of localized malformations of the cerebral cortex involving abnormal cortical layering, cell types, or both. It can cause focal epilepsy; subtypes are distinguished by tissue findings, and some are associated with drug-resistant seizures.

Alternate Names:
FCD

Focal Dermal Hypoplasia Syndrome

A rare X-linked disorder, usually in females, with thin or absent areas of skin following Blaschko lines and variable abnormalities of limbs, teeth, eyes, hair, and other organs. Management is multidisciplinary and tailored to the findings.

Focal Glomerulosclerosis

Scarring affecting some kidney filters or only parts of affected filters. It can cause protein to leak into urine, swelling, high blood pressure, and gradual loss of kidney function.

Focal Impaired Awareness Seizures

Focal-onset seizures in which awareness is impaired during part or all of the seizure. Automatisms, behavioral arrest, confusion, and postictal amnesia may occur.

Focal Neurological Deficit

Alternate spelling; see *Focal Neurologic Deficits*.

Focal Neurologic Deficits

Loss of a particular function, such as strength, sensation, speech, vision, or coordination, because of a localized problem in the brain, spinal cord, or a nerve. Sudden onset may indicate stroke.

Focal Neuropathy

Damage or irritation affecting one peripheral nerve or a small group of nerves. It may cause pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or altered movement in the area supplied by those nerves.

Alternate Names:
Mononeuropathy; Isolated Nerve Lesion

Focal Nodular Hyperplasia

A usually harmless overgrowth of liver tissue related to an unusual local blood supply. It often causes no symptoms, is found on imaging, and rarely needs treatment unless its diagnosis is uncertain.

Focal-Onset Seizure

A seizure that begins in one area of the brain. Awareness may remain normal or become impaired, and symptoms depend on the affected area; the seizure may spread and cause whole-body stiffening and jerking.

Focal Sclerosis

Hardening or scarring limited to a particular area of tissue. In the kidney, it may describe scarring of some filters or parts of filters, which can impair filtration and cause protein in urine.

Focal Segmental Glomerular Sclerosis

Alternate form; see *Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis*.

Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis

A kidney disease or pattern of injury in which scarring affects some kidney filters or parts of them. It can cause protein in the urine, swelling, high blood pressure, or kidney failure; it may be primary or secondary to another condition.

Focal Seizure

A seizure that begins in one area of the brain. It may cause unusual movement, sensation, behavior, emotion, or awareness and can spread to involve both sides of the brain.

Focused Assessment with Sonography for Trauma

A rapid bedside point-of-care ultrasonographic examination performed in acute trauma resuscitation to screen for free intraperitoneal blood (Morison pouch, splenorenal recess, pelvis) and hemopericardium (subxiphoid view).

Alternate Names:
FAST Exam; Trauma Ultrasound

Focus Words

Words or short phrases used during relaxation or stress-management exercises to direct attention and support calm breathing. They may help coping but are not a treatment for an underlying medical disorder.

FODMAP

An acronym for Fermentable Oligosaccharides, Disaccharides, Monosaccharides, And Polyols—a collection of short-chain dietary carbohydrates and sugar alcohols that are poorly or incompletely absorbed in the human small intestine. Encompasses fructans (found in wheat, rye, onions, garlic), galactooligosaccharides (GOS, found in legumes), lactose (dairy), excess fructose (honey, apples), and polyols (sorbitol, mannitol, xylitol). Due to small molecular size, unabsorbed FODMAPs exert an osmotic draw that increases small intestinal water volume, and upon transit to the colon, undergo rapid enzymatic fermentation by resident gut microbiota, generating hydrogen, methane, and short-chain fatty acids. In individuals with visceral hypersensitivity (notably irritable bowel syndrome [IBS]), this luminal distension provokes symptoms of bloating, abdominal pain, flatulence, and altered bowel habits. A short-term low-FODMAP elimination diet followed by systematic reintroduction is an established clinical therapeutic dietary intervention for IBS.

Alternate Names:
FODMAPs; Fermentable Carbohydrates

FODMAP Diet

A short-term eating plan that reduces certain poorly absorbed carbohydrates that can cause gas, bloating, pain, or diarrhea. Foods are gradually reintroduced with professional guidance to identify personal triggers.

FODMAPs

Plural form; see *FODMAP*.

Foetal Acidosis

Excess acidity in fetal blood, usually caused by inadequate oxygen delivery or impaired gas exchange. Fetal heart-rate monitoring and, in selected situations, blood testing help assess its likelihood and severity.

Foetal Alcohol Syndrome

A lifelong condition caused by alcohol exposure before birth, with characteristic facial features, poor growth, and brain-development problems affecting learning, behavior, or coordination. No amount of alcohol is known to be safe during pregnancy.

Foetor Hepaticus

A distinctive, sweet, musty, or breath odor resembling rotten eggs and garlic, caused by the exhalation of volatile dimethyl sulfide and mercaptans that bypass hepatic metabolism due to portosystemic shunting and severe liver failure.

Alternate Names:
Fetor Hepaticus; Breath of the Dead

Foetus

The developing human offspring from the end of the embryonic period, about nine weeks after fertilization, until birth. During this period, organs grow and mature and body functions become more coordinated.

Foix-Alajouanine Syndrome

A subacute necrotizing myelopathy caused by a slow-flow spinal dural arteriovenous fistula (dAVF), resulting in chronic spinal venous hypertension, progressive venous congestion, ischemic myelopathy, and lower-extremity paraparesis with sphincter impairment.

Alternate Names:
Subacute Necrotic Myelopathy; Spinal Dural AV Fistula Myelopathy

Folate

Vitamin B9, needed for DNA production, cell division, and healthy red blood cells. Adequate folate before and during early pregnancy lowers neural-tube-defect risk; high-dose supplements can correct anemia while nerve damage from vitamin B12 deficiency continues.

Folate Antagonist

A medicine that blocks folate-related processes needed to make DNA. Depending on the drug, it may treat cancer, inflammatory disease, or bacterial infection, but can cause low blood counts, mouth sores, or liver problems.

Folate Deficiency

Too little vitamin B9, caused by poor intake, increased need, malabsorption, alcohol use, or some medicines. It can cause large abnormal red blood cells, anemia, fatigue, sore tongue, and pregnancy complications.

Folate Deficiency Anemia

Anemia caused by too little folate, or vitamin B9. Red blood cells become unusually large and immature, causing fatigue, weakness, pale skin, shortness of breath, or a sore tongue. Blood tests help confirm the cause, and folate replacement is given after vitamin B12 deficiency is considered.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin B9 Deficiency Anemia; Megaloblastic Folate Anemia

Folate-Deficiency Anemia

Alternate spelling; see *Folate Deficiency Anemia*.

Folate Test

A blood test measuring serum or red blood cell folate (vitamin B9) to assess nutritional status and investigate macrocytic anemia; see *Folate*.

Folate Vitamin B9

Alternate name; see *Folate*.

Foley Catheter

A flexible tube placed through the urethra into the bladder to drain urine. A small balloon holds it in place; risks include discomfort, blockage, urinary infection, and urethral injury.

Folic Acid

A manufactured form of vitamin B9 needed for DNA production and healthy blood cells. Supplements prevent many fetal neural-tube defects when taken before conception and treat folate deficiency.

Folic Acid And Birth Defect Prevention

Taking folic acid before conception and during early pregnancy reduces the risk of neural-tube defects, which affect development of the fetal brain and spinal cord. Higher-risk people may need a prescribed dose.

Folic Acid Deficiency Anemia

Alternate name; see *Folate Deficiency Anemia*.

Folic Acid In Diet

Folate occurs naturally in leafy vegetables, beans, citrus fruits, and liver, while folic acid is added to some fortified foods. Intake supports blood formation and fetal development; needs increase during pregnancy.

Folic Acid Supplementation

Use of folic acid, a form of vitamin B9, to reduce neural-tube-defect risk when taken before conception and during early pregnancy or to treat folate deficiency. The amount used depends on the clinical indication and individual risk.

Folic Acid Test

A clinical laboratory blood test measuring serum or red blood cell folate concentrations to evaluate megaloblastic anemia, malnutrition, malabsorption syndromes, or dietary deficiency.

Alternate Names:
Folate Blood Test

Folie a Deux

A psychiatric syndrome in which a delusional belief or paranoid ideation is transmitted from an individual with an established primary psychotic disorder to one or more emotionally close, dependent individuals who share the delusion.

Alternate Names:
Shared Psychotic Disorder; Shared Delusional Disorder

Folinic Acid

A reduced form of folate used to prevent or treat folate-antagonist toxicity and to support selected chemotherapy regimens.

Alternate Names:
Leucovorin; Calcium Folinate

Follicle

A small sac or organized tissue structure. A hair follicle produces a hair, while an ovarian follicle contains a developing egg; other follicles can occur in glands or lymphatic tissue.

Follicle Stimulating Hormone

Alternate spelling; see *Follicle-Stimulating Hormone*.

Follicle-Stimulating Hormone

A hormone released by the pituitary gland. It supports egg-containing follicle development and estrogen production in females and sperm production in males. Its level varies with age and reproductive stage.

Follicle-Stimulating Hormone Abnormalities

Abnormally high or low FSH levels may reflect altered ovarian or testicular function, pituitary or hypothalamic disease, menopause, pregnancy, medicines, or a changing menstrual cycle. Interpretation requires age, sex, reproductive stage, and related hormone tests.

Follicle-Stimulating Hormone Blood Test

A blood test measuring a hormone involved in ovarian function and sperm production. It helps evaluate infertility, menstrual changes, puberty problems, menopause, testicular or ovarian failure, and pituitary disorders.

Follicular

Relating to a follicle, especially a hair follicle or an ovarian follicle. A follicular skin problem is centered around a hair and may appear as a bump, pustule, plug, or inflamed area.

Follicular Cyst

A usually harmless ovarian cyst that forms when a follicle does not release an egg or does not shrink normally. It often causes no symptoms and disappears within a few menstrual cycles without treatment.

Follicular Fluid

The liquid inside an ovarian follicle surrounding a developing egg. It contains hormones and other substances that support follicle growth and help coordinate ovulation.

Follicular Hyperkeratosis

Excess keratin blocking hair follicles and causing small rough bumps. It commonly occurs with keratosis pilaris and, less often, with nutritional deficiency or other skin conditions.

Follicular Lymphoma

A usually slow-growing cancer of immune cells that often causes painless swelling of lymph nodes. It may involve bone marrow or other organs and can sometimes change into a faster-growing lymphoma.

Follicular Thyroid Carcinoma

A thyroid cancer that begins in follicle-forming cells and can spread through the bloodstream, especially to bone or lungs. Tissue examination is needed to show invasion and distinguish it from a benign growth.

Follicular Unit

A natural group of one or more hair follicles along with nearby skin glands, nerves, and tiny muscles. Hair-transplant procedures may move these units from a fuller area to a thinning area.

Follicular Unit Transplantation

Hair-restoration surgery that moves natural groups of hair follicles from a donor area to thinning or bald areas. Results take months, and possible problems include scarring, infection, and continued hair loss.

Alternate Names:
FUT; Strip Hair Restoration

Folliculitis

An acute superficial or deep inflammatory reaction of the hair follicle, most frequently triggered by infectious microbial pathogens or chemical and physical irritation. Classified etiologically into: bacterial folliculitis, most commonly caused by *Staphylococ-*

cus aureus (superficial folliculitis or Bockhart impetigo, and deep folliculitis progressing to furuncles and carbuncles); "hot tub" folliculitis, caused by *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* contaminating poorly chlorinated heated water; fungal folliculitis, notably *Pityrosporum* (Malassezia) folliculitis (pruritic monomorphic follicular papules and pustules on the upper chest and back) and dermatophytic fungal folliculitis (Majocchi granuloma); viral folliculitis (herpetic folliculitis); and non-infectious variants including folliculitis decalvans, eosinophilic folliculitis (frequently associated with advanced HIV infection), and pseudofolliculitis barbae (mechanical inflammatory foreign-body reaction to ingrown, closely shaved facial hairs in individuals with curly hair). Clinically manifests as crops of small, dome-shaped, erythematous follicular papules or pustules centered on hair shafts, often accompanied by pruritus or tenderness. Diagnosis is primarily clinical, supported by Gram stain, bacterial/fungal culture, or dermoscopy. Mild superficial bacterial cases resolve spontaneously or respond to topical antiseptics (chlorhexidine) or topical antibiotics (mupirocin, clindamycin); widespread, recurrent, or deep-seated folliculitis warrants targeted oral antimicrobials.

Folliculitis Decalvans

A rare inflammatory scalp disorder causing repeated pustules, crusting, hair loss, and permanent scarring. Early dermatologic treatment aims to control inflammation and infection and limit further follicle destruction.

Fomentation

Applying a warm, moist cloth or material to part of the body to soothe pain, relax muscles, or improve comfort. Excessive heat can burn skin.

Fomepizole

An antidote for poisoning with methanol or ethylene glycol. It blocks formation of their toxic breakdown products and may be combined with intensive supportive care and dialysis.

Fomite

A nonliving object or surface that carries an infectious organism and can pass it to a person through contact. Examples include contaminated medical equipment and shared items; transmission requires the organism to survive on the object and reach a person's eyes, nose, mouth, or broken skin.

Fomites

Plural form; see *Fomite*.

Fondaparinux

An injectable anticoagulant that prevents formation or extension of blood clots by blocking activated factor X. It is used for selected clotting disorders and prevention after surgery; bleeding is its main risk.

Fondaparinux Sodium

The sodium salt form of fondaparinux, an injectable medicine that reduces clotting by blocking activated factor X. It treats or prevents selected blood clots but can cause serious bleeding and requires dose adjustment in kidney disease.

Fong Disease

Alternate name; see *Nail-Patella Syndrome*.

Fonofos

A highly poisonous organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness.

Fonsecaea

A group of darkly pigmented fungi that can cause slow-growing skin and soft-tissue infections called chromoblastomycosis. Infection usually follows injury and may produce warty plaques or nodules, especially in tropical regions.

Fontanel

A soft gap between an infant's skull bones that allows the brain and skull to grow and helps the skull mold during birth. Its size and firmness can provide clues about hydration or pressure inside the skull.

Fontanelle

A soft membranous space between an infant's skull bones. Fontanelles allow growth and molding during birth; the front one usually closes during the second year, while the back one closes earlier.

Fontan Procedure

An operation for some children born with only one effective pumping chamber. It directs blood returning from the body to the lungs without a separate pumping chamber, improving circulation but requiring lifelong follow-up for rhythm, heart, liver, clotting, and protein-loss problems.

Alternate Names:
Fontan Operation; Total Cavopulmonary Connection (TCPC)

Food Addiction

A nonformal term for intense cravings or loss of control around eating. It is not a universally accepted diagnosis; related factors include binge-eating disorder, mood, stress, medicines, sleep, and access to food.

Food Additives

Substances added to food to preserve it or change its flavor, color, texture, or stability. Most are safe in approved amounts, but some people may have intolerance or allergy to particular additives.

Food Allergies

Plural form; see *Food Allergy*.

Food Allergy

An immune reaction to a food protein that can cause skin, gastrointestinal, respiratory, or cardiovascular symptoms. Reactions range from localized symptoms to anaphylaxis; common triggers include milk, egg, peanut, tree nuts, fish, shellfish, soy, and wheat.

Foodborne Disease

Illness acquired by eating or drinking material contaminated with germs, toxins, or harmful chemicals. Severity ranges from brief diarrhea to dehydration, organ damage, or life-threatening infection.

Food-Borne Illness

Illness caused by eating food contaminated with bacteria, viruses, parasites, toxins, or chemicals. Symptoms commonly include nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, cramps, and fever; safe handling and cooking help prevent it.

Alternate Names:
Food Poisoning; Acute Alimentary Toxicosis

Food Contamination

The presence of harmful germs, toxins, chemicals, allergens, or foreign materials in food. Contamination can occur during production, storage, preparation, or serving and may cause infection, poisoning, allergic reactions, or injury.

Food Hygiene

Practices that prevent food contamination and foodborne illness, including washing hands, separating raw and cooked foods, cooking thoroughly, chilling promptly, and using safe water.

Food Intolerance

A troublesome reaction to a food that does not involve the immune system. Lactose intolerance is common; symptoms may include gas, bloating, cramps, or diarrhea and depend on the food and amount.

Food Jags

A child's repeated preference for only a few foods or refusal of foods previously accepted. It is common during development but may limit nutrition, growth, or social eating or cause distress.

Food Poisoning

Illness from eating food contaminated with germs, toxins, or harmful chemicals. Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and fever are common.

Food Protein-Induced Allergic Proctocolitis

A non-IgE-mediated food reaction, usually in an

infant, causing inflammation of the lower bowel and visible blood or mucus in otherwise well-appearing stools. Cow's-milk or soy protein is often involved.

Food Protein-Induced Enterocolitis Syndrome

A delayed, non-IgE-mediated food allergy that usually causes repeated vomiting, diarrhea, pallor, lethargy, or dehydration several hours after eating a trigger food. It is most common in infants and young children.

Food Safety

Handling, storing, preparing, and labeling food in ways that prevent germs, toxins, harmful chemicals, and allergens from causing illness.

Food Supplement

A product taken to add nutrients or other substances to the diet, such as vitamins, minerals, herbs, or protein. Supplements can interact with medicines and are not automatically safe or effective.

Foot

The part of the lower limb below the ankle, made of bones, joints, muscles, tendons, ligaments, nerves, and blood vessels. Its shape and arches support standing, balance, shock absorption, and walking.

Foot Abscess

A pocket of pus in the skin or deeper tissues of the foot, usually caused by bacteria entering through a wound or ulcer. It can cause a painful, warm, swollen area; see also *Abscess*.

Foot Cellulitis

A bacterial infection of the skin and tissue beneath it in the foot. The area may become painful, warm, swollen, or discolored; see also *Cellulitis*.

Foot Drop

Difficulty lifting the front of the foot because of weakness in the ankle and foot muscles. It may cause tripping or a high-stepping walk and can result from nerve injury, spinal disease, muscle disease, or stroke.

Alternate Names:
Drop Foot

Foot Fracture

A break in one or more foot bones caused by sudden injury, repeated stress, or weakened bone. Pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty bearing weight are common; treatment ranges from protection and immobilization to surgery.

Foot Gangrene

Death of tissue in part of the foot, often a toe, usually because blood flow is severely reduced or infection has damaged the tissue. The area may become dark, cold, numb, swollen, or foul-smelling; see also *Gangrene*.

Footling Breech

A breech presentation in which one or both fetal feet lie below the buttocks and present first. It is associated with increased risks of umbilical cord prolapse and entrapment of the after-coming head; delivery planning depends on gestational age, labor progress, and the applicable clinical protocol.

Alternate Names:
Footling Breech Presentation

Foot Lymphedema

Long-lasting swelling of the foot caused by poor drainage of lymph fluid. It may affect the toes and top of the foot and can make the skin feel tight or become thicker; see also *Lymphedema*.

Foot Osteomyelitis

Infection of one or more bones in the foot, sometimes spreading from a nearby wound or ulcer. It can cause lasting pain, swelling, or tenderness and sometimes fever; see also *Osteomyelitis*.

Foot Pain

Pain in the foot caused by injury, overuse, arthritis, nerve problems, infection, or poor circulation. It may be persistent or accompanied by inability to bear weight, numbness, discoloration, fever, or an

open wound.

Foot Pain (Plantar Fasciitis)

Foot pain caused by plantar fasciitis, a disorder of the strong band of tissue supporting the sole. Pain is often felt near the heel and may be worst with the first steps after sleep or rest; see also *Foot Pain*.

FOP

Abbreviation; see *Fibrodysplasia Ossificans Progressiva*.

Foramen

A natural opening or passage through a bone or other body structure, usually allowing a nerve, blood vessel, or other tissue to pass.

Foramen Lacerum

A triangular, irregular aperture in the middle cranial fossa base bounded by the sphenoid, apex of the petrous temporal, and basilar occipital bones, filled with fibrocartilage in life and crossed superiorly by the internal carotid artery as it enters the cavernous sinus.

Foramen of Monro

A paired, crescent-shaped aperture situated between the column of the fornix and the anterior pole of the thalamus connecting each lateral cerebral ventricle with the midline third ventricle, permitting the physiological circulation of cerebrospinal fluid.

Alternate Names:
Interventricular Foramen

Foramen Ovale

An opening between the upper chambers of the fetal heart that directs blood away from the lungs before birth. It usually closes after birth; if it remains open, the condition is called patent foramen ovale.

Foramen Rotundum

A circular bony canal in the greater wing of the sphenoid bone that connects the middle cranial fossa with the pterygopalatine fossa, transmitting the maxillary division of the trigeminal nerve (cranial nerve V2).

Foramen Spinosum

A small, round aperture located posterolateral to the foramen ovale in the greater wing of the sphenoid bone, transmitting the middle meningeal artery, middle meningeal vein, and the nervous spinosus (meningeal branch of CN V3) into the cranial cavity.

Foraminotomy

Surgery that enlarges an opening where a spinal nerve leaves the backbone, relieving pressure caused by arthritis, a disc problem, or other narrowing. Risks include infection, bleeding, nerve injury, and persistent symptoms.

Forbes-Albright Syndrome

A clinical syndrome characterized by hyperprolactinemia, galactorrhea, and amenorrhea in women in the absence of recent pregnancy, classically caused by a prolactin-secreting pituitary adenoma (prolactinoma).

Forced Expiratory Volume

The amount of air forcefully exhaled during a measured time after taking a full breath. The first-second value helps assess narrowed or restricted airways and is interpreted with other lung-test results.

Forced Oscillation Technique

A breathing test in which a device sends gentle pressure waves through the airways while a person breathes normally. It measures how easily air moves and can help assess lung disease when forceful breathing tests are difficult.

Forced Vital Capacity

The total amount of air forcefully exhaled after a person breathes in fully. A low value may occur when the lungs are small or stiff or when airways prevent complete emptying.

Force Plates

Platforms that measure forces beneath the feet dur-

ing standing, walking, or other movement. Clinicians and researchers use them to assess balance, gait, symmetry, and how weight is distributed.

Forceps

A handheld instrument used to grasp, hold, or move tissue or medical materials. Different designs have smooth or toothed tips and are chosen according to the procedure.

Forceps-Assisted Delivery

A vaginal delivery assisted by placing forceps around the fetal head. It is considered only when the cervix is fully open, the head's position is known, and vaginal birth is judged safe; maternal and newborn injuries can occur.

Forceps Delivery

An assisted vaginal birth in which forceps guide the baby's head out of the birth canal. It may be used for prolonged labor, concerning fetal findings, or inability to push safely; tears and newborn injury are possible.

Forchheimer Spots

Small red spots on the soft palate that may appear around the time a rubella rash begins. They are not specific to rubella and do not confirm the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Forchheimer's Spots; Rubella Enanthem

Forcible Intercourse

Sexual intercourse without freely given consent, involving force, threats, coercion, or inability to consent. It is sexual violence and may cause physical injury, pregnancy, sexually transmitted infection, or psychological trauma.

Fordyce Granules

Visible oil glands that appear as tiny, painless white or yellow bumps on the lips, inside the mouth, or genitals, including the penis. They are a common normal variation and are not an infection or sexually transmitted disease.

Alternate Names:
Fordyce Spots; Fordyce's Granules

Fordyce's Angiokeratomas

Small, usually harmless dark-red or purple spots caused by widened tiny blood vessels, commonly on the scrotum or vulva. They may bleed after injury; other lesions can resemble them.

Forearm

The part of the arm between the elbow and wrist, containing the radius and ulna bones, muscles, tendons, nerves, and blood vessels.

Forearm Circumference

The distance around the forearm at a specified point. Measurement can help monitor growth, muscle loss, swelling, nutrition, or changes during treatment and rehabilitation.

Forehead

The part of the face above the eyebrows and in front of the frontal skull bone. It contains skin, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels and helps with facial expression and protection.

Forehead Lift

Cosmetic surgery that raises drooping eyebrows or forehead skin and may reduce wrinkles. Risks include scarring, numbness, asymmetry, hairline changes, bleeding, infection, and nerve injury.

Alternate Names:
Brow Lift

Foreign Body

An object that is not normally part of the body and becomes lodged in tissue or a body passage, such as glass, metal, food, or a splinter. It may cause injury, blockage, infection, or inflammation.

Foreign Body Airway Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of the breathing passages by an inhaled object or material. Severe choking with inability to speak, cough, or breathe is life-threatening.

Foreign Body Aspiration

Inhalation of an object or food into the airway, especially in young children. Choking, persistent cough, wheezing, noisy breathing, or reduced breath sounds may occur; complete blockage is an emergency.

Foreign-Body Aspiration

Alternate spelling; see *Foreign Body Aspiration*.

Foreign Body in Ear

Alternate name; see *Ear Foreign Body*.

Foreign Body In The Nose

An object lodged in a nasal passage, often in a child. One-sided blockage, foul discharge, bleeding, pain, or difficulty breathing may occur; safe removal prevents tissue damage and infection.

Foreign Body Reaction

Inflammation around material that remains in tissue, such as a splinter, stitch, implant, or device. It may cause a lump, redness, pain, drainage, or scar tissue and can resemble infection.

Forensic

Pertaining to, suitable for, or applied in court proceedings, legal investigations, or the judicial administration of justice. In medical science, forensic medicine (medicolegal practice) encompasses the application of medical, surgical, and scientific knowledge to legal questions, including postmortem examinations (forensic pathology) to determine the cause and manner of death (natural, accidental, suicide, homicide, or undetermined), clinical forensic examinations of living victims of assault, trauma, or toxic exposure, forensic toxicology, forensic odontology, and the rigorous preservation of chain of custody for biological evidence.

Alternate Names:
Forensics; Legal Medicine; Medicolegal

Forensic Anthropology

The examination of human remains, especially bones, for legal investigations. It can help determine whether remains are human, estimate biological characteristics, assess injury, and support identification.

Forensic Autopsy

A specialized post-mortem examination performed under statutory or judicial authority by a forensic pathologist or medical examiner to determine the cause and manner of violent, sudden, suspicious, unnatural, or unattended deaths and preserve legal evidence.

Alternate Names:
Medico-Legal Autopsy; Coroner Post-Mortem

Forensic Autopsy of Blunt Force Trauma

Postmortem examination of injuries caused by blunt impact, including abrasions, contusions, lacerations, fractures, and internal organ damage. Wound patterns, distribution, vitality, and associated evidence help reconstruct the event.

Forensic Autopsy of Sharp Force Injuries

Postmortem examination of incised, stab, chop, or other sharp-force wounds. The examiner documents wound morphology, depth, direction, vital reaction, clothing damage, and associated injuries to help determine mechanism and manner of death.

Forensic Defense Wounds

Injuries, often on the hands or forearms, that may occur when a person raises or uses the limbs to block an attack. Their location and pattern may be consistent with a defensive action, but they do not by themselves prove that an assault occurred or establish how the injuries were caused.

Alternate Names:
Forensic Defense Injuries

Forensic Evidence

Physical, biological, digital, or documentary material collected and analyzed during a legal investigation. Examples include blood, DNA, fibers, fingerprints, toxicology samples, photographs, and medical records.

Forensic Examination

A structured medical or scientific assessment performed for legal purposes. It may document injuries, collect evidence after assault, assess impairment, examine a death, or analyze a scene or specimen.

Forensic Genetics

The use of DNA testing to identify people, establish biological relationships, or compare biological evidence in legal investigations. Results require proper collection, chain of custody, and expert interpretation.

Forensic Laceration

A torn wound caused by blunt force, usually with irregular bruised edges and tissue strands crossing the wound. These features help distinguish it from a clean cut caused by a sharp object.

Alternate Names:
Blunt Force Tear

Forensic Odontology

The use of dental knowledge in legal investigations. Comparing teeth, dental records, and radiographs can help identify remains and document dental injuries or other evidence.

Forensic Pathology

A branch of pathology that applies medical knowledge to the investigation of deaths with legal or public-safety importance. Forensic pathologists examine the body and consider medical history and the circumstances of death, often including an autopsy, to determine the cause and manner of death.

Forensic Pathology of Firearm Wounds

Examination of firearm-related injuries, including entrance and exit wounds, soot, stippling, bullet paths, projectile effects, clothing damage, and range-of-fire findings, integrated with imaging, scene evidence, and recovered bullets.

Forensic Pathology of Thermal Injuries

Examination of burns and other heat-related injuries, including burn depth and distribution, soot or airway injury, heat artifacts, and evidence of vital reaction. Findings are interpreted with scene information and toxicology.

Forensic Psychiatry

A subspecialty of psychiatry applying clinical and scientific expertise to legal questions in civil, criminal, correctional, regulatory, and administrative settings. It includes psychiatric assessments related to competence to stand trial, criminal responsibility, decision-making capacity, and risk, as well as consultation and research at the intersection of mental health and law.

Forensic Radiography

The use of X-rays, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, or other imaging in legal investigations. It can identify people, document injuries, locate objects, assess trauma, and support death investigations.

Forensics

Plural form; see *Forensic*.

Forensic Toxicology

The testing of blood, urine, hair, tissue, or other specimens for medicines, alcohol, drugs, poisons, and their breakdown products to assess possible roles in illness, impairment, poisoning, or death.

Forensic Toxicology Screen

An initial laboratory test of biological samples for medicines, alcohol, drugs, poisons, or their breakdown products. A positive screen usually needs confirmation and measurement before legal or medical conclusions are made.

Foreskin

The fold of skin covering and protecting the head of the penis. It normally becomes retractable over time; forceful retraction can cause pain, tearing, or scarring.

Alternate Names:
Prepuce; Penile Prepuce

Formaldehyde

A strong-smelling chemical used in manufacturing and tissue preservation. It can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways, cause allergic reactions, and increase cancer risk with substantial or long-term exposure.

Formalin

A water-based solution of formaldehyde used to preserve tissue for laboratory examination. It can irritate or burn the skin, eyes, and airways; laboratory handling uses ventilation and protective equipment.

Formalin-Fixed Paraffin-Embedded Tissue

Tissue preserved in formalin, processed, and embedded in wax so thin sections can be examined. These blocks support microscopic, protein, and many genetic tests, although preservation can alter some results.

Formate

A salt or ester of formic acid. In medicine, formate is important because it is a toxic breakdown product of methanol and can contribute to severe acidosis and vision loss after poisoning.

Formed Elements Of Blood

The cells and cell fragments suspended in blood: red blood cells carry oxygen, white blood cells help defend against infection, and platelets help form clots and stop bleeding.

Formetanate

A carbamate insecticide that can poison the nervous system by disrupting acetylcholine breakdown. Exposure may cause sweating, vomiting, small pupils, muscle weakness, breathing difficulty, or seizures.

Formication

The feeling that insects are crawling on or under the skin when none are present. It may occur with nerve disease, menopause, substance withdrawal, medicines, or psychiatric illness; persistent symptoms can be associated with an underlying condition.

Formoterol Fumarate

A long-acting beta-2 agonist that relaxes airway muscle and helps prevent bronchoconstriction. It is used with an inhaled corticosteroid for asthma and with other inhaled medicines for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. In asthma, an inhaled corticosteroid-formoterol combination can serve as both maintenance and reliever therapy in selected regimens; formoterol alone is not an asthma reliever.

Formothion

An organophosphate insecticide that can poison the nervous system. Exposure may cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness; severe poisoning can be fatal.

Formparanate

A carbamate pesticide. Significant exposure can cause cholinergic poisoning, with excess saliva, sweating, tearing, vomiting, small pupils, muscle weakness, and breathing problems; suspected poisoning is an emergency.

Formulae

The plural of formula. In healthcare, the word may mean mathematical equations, medicine formulations, or prepared nutritional products such as infant formula.

Formula Feed

Prepared infant nutrition given by bottle, cup, or feeding tube when breast milk is unavailable, insufficient, or not chosen. Formulas and preparation methods vary with infant age and medical needs.

Formula Feeding

Feeding an infant with commercially prepared formula instead of or in addition to breast milk. Safe preparation, clean equipment, correct dilution, and age-appropriate amounts help prevent infection, dehydration, and poor nutrition.

Formulary

A list of medicines approved or preferred by a health system, insurer, or institution. It may show cover-

age, restrictions, alternatives, and requirements for approval, but does not replace a clinician's prescribing judgment.

Fornix

A recess or arch-shaped structure. In the eye, the conjunctival fornix is the fold where the eyelid lining joins the surface covering the eyeball; the term also describes parts of the brain and vagina.

Forrest Classification

A standardized, internationally recognized endoscopic classification system used to stratify peptic ulcer hemorrhage into risk categories for rebleeding and determine the necessity of endoscopic hemostasis. Subdivided into active spurting hemorrhage (Ia), active oozing (Ib), visible non-bleeding vessel (IIa), adherent clot (IIb), pigmented flat spot (IIc), and clean-based ulcer (III).

Alternate Names:
Forrest Endoscopic Bleeding Criteria; Forrest Staging

Forrester Classification

A system that groups people with severe heart failure or shock according to blood flow and congestion. "Warm" means adequate flow and "cold" reduced flow; "dry" means little congestion and "wet" significant congestion, helping guide treatment.

Alternate Names:
Forrester Hemodynamic Subsets

Fortification

Adding vitamins or minerals to foods to improve nutritional intake and prevent deficiency. Examples include iodine in salt, vitamin D in some dairy products, and folic acid in many grain products.

Fortified Wine

Wine with added distilled alcohol, giving it a higher alcohol content than ordinary wine. Excess use can cause intoxication, dependence, liver disease, injuries, and interactions with medicines.

Fosaprepitant Dimeglumine

An intravenous medicine converted to aprepitant that blocks a brain signaling pathway involved in nausea and vomiting. It helps prevent chemotherapy-related sickness and can interact with other medicines.

Foscarnet Sodium

An antiviral medicine used for selected serious or resistant cytomegalovirus and herpesvirus infections. It can damage the kidneys and disturb blood salts; treatment commonly includes hydration and laboratory monitoring.

Fosfomycin

An antibiotic that blocks an early step in bacterial cell-wall production. It is used for selected urinary or difficult-to-treat infections; diarrhea, allergic reactions, and resistance can occur.

Fosinopril

An angiotensin-converting enzyme inhibitor used for high blood pressure and some forms of heart failure. It relaxes blood vessels and reduces fluid strain; cough, high potassium, kidney problems, or swelling can occur.

Fossa

A shallow hollow or depression in a bone or other body structure. It may provide space for a joint, muscle, blood vessel, nerve, gland, or part of an organ.

Fossa Navicularis

An expanded, boat-shaped anatomical dilation of the penile urethra situated within the glans penis immediately proximal to the external urethral meatus, lined by non-keratinized stratified squamous epithelium.

Alternate Names:
Navicular Fossa of the Urethra

Fossula

A small pit or shallow depression in an anatomical structure. Examples include small depressions in a

bone or on a tooth; the term describes shape and location rather than a disease.

Foster Kennedy Syndrome

A neuro-ophthalmic syndrome characterized by ipsilateral optic atrophy and anosmia (due to direct compression of the optic nerve and olfactory tract by an anterior cranial fossa tumor, such as an olfactory groove meningioma) and contralateral papilledema (due to raised intracranial pressure).

Alternate Names:
Kennedy Syndrome; Gowers-Paton-Kennedy Syndrome

Fotemustine

A chemotherapy medicine that can cross into the brain and is used in some countries for selected advanced cancers. It can suppress bone marrow, increasing the risk of infection and bleeding.

Fothergill Sign

A physical examination test used to differentiate an abdominal wall mass (such as a rectus sheath hematoma) from an intra-abdominal mass; a hematoma or mass within the rectus sheath does not cross the midline and remains fixed and palpable during contraction of the rectus abdominis muscles when the patient raises their head.

Alternate Names:
Fothergill's Sign; Rectus Sheath Hematoma Sign

Foul Breath

Alternate name; see *Halitosis*.

Foul-Smelling Stools

Strongly odorous feces that may result from diet, infection, bleeding, malabsorption, altered gut bacteria, or rapid transit; persistent change with weight loss or diarrhea warrants review.

Found Dead

A circumstance in which a person is discovered deceased without the death having been observed. Medical or forensic examination may determine identity, timing, cause, and manner of death.

Fourchette

The small fold of tissue at the back of the opening of the vulva, where the inner labial folds meet. It may stretch or tear during childbirth or sexual injury.

Four-Dimensional Ultrasound

Three-dimensional ultrasound shown as movement over time, creating a live view. It may help assess fetal anatomy or other structures, but image quality and diagnostic value depend on the examination and equipment.

Fourier Analysis

A mathematical method that separates a complex signal into simpler repeating frequencies. It is used in medical imaging, heart and brain signal analysis, and other measurements to identify patterns.

Fournier Disease

Alternate name; see *Fournier Gangrene*.

Fournier Gangrene

A rapidly spreading, life-threatening infection that destroys tissue around the genitals, perineum, or anus. It may cause severe pain, swelling, fever, skin discoloration, or systemic illness.

Alternate Names:
Fournier's Gangrene; Fournier's Gangrene

Fourth-Degree Tear

A severe childbirth tear extending from the vaginal area through the anal sphincter and into the rectal lining. It can cause pain, infection, and later bowel-control problems; treatment involves surgical repair and follow-up.

Fourth Finger

The ring finger, located between the middle finger and little finger. It contains bones, joints, tendons, nerves, blood vessels, and skin that support movement and grasping.

Fourth Heart Sound

A low-pitched sound heard in late diastole, just before the first heart sound, when atrial contraction

fills the ventricle. It is commonly associated with reduced ventricular compliance, although increased late filling can produce it in other settings.

Fourth Stage Of Labor

The first hours after the placenta is delivered, when the birthing person is closely observed for heavy bleeding, abnormal blood pressure, poor uterine contraction, pain, and other early complications.

Fourth Venereal Disease

Alternate name; see *Lymphogranuloma Venereum*.

Fovea

A tiny central depression in the retina responsible for the sharpest detailed and color vision. Damage to it can impair reading, face recognition, and central vision.

Fovea Centralis

Alternate name; see *Fovea*.

Foville Syndrome

An inferior medial pontine stroke syndrome typically resulting from occlusion of paramedian perforating branches of the basilar artery. Characterized by ipsilateral facial paralysis (cranial nerve VII), ipsilateral horizontal conjugate gaze palsy (abducens nucleus or PPRF), and contralateral hemiplegia of the upper and lower extremities (corticospinal tract).

Alternate Names:
Foville Inferior Pontine Syndrome

Fowler Position

A bed position in which a person lies on the back with the head of the bed raised, often 45 to 90 degrees from horizontal. High Fowler position is near upright, at about 90 degrees. The exact angle range can vary by clinical convention.

Fowler's Syndrome

A rare cause of persistent difficulty emptying the bladder, usually in young women, related to abnormal relaxation of the urethral sphincter. Diagnostic evaluation excludes blockage and nerve disease; treatment may involve drainage or neuromodulation.

Fox-Fordyce Disease

A rare chronic skin disorder caused by blocked and inflamed sweat glands. It produces intensely itchy small bumps, commonly in the armpits, pubic region, or around the nipples.

Foxglove Poisoning

Poisoning from foxglove plants or medicines containing cardiac glycosides. It can cause nausea, vomiting, confusion, visual changes, dangerously slow or irregular heart rhythms, or cardiac arrest.

Fractional Excretion Of Sodium

The percentage of filtered sodium leaving the body in urine. It can help assess kidney function and distinguish reduced kidney blood flow from some tubular injuries, but diuretics and other illnesses can make it misleading.

Fractional Excretion of Urea

The percentage of filtered urea excreted in urine. It can support assessment of kidney blood flow when diuretics affect sodium testing, but infection, bleeding, nutrition, and chronic kidney disease also influence the result.

Alternate Names:
FEUrea; Urinary Urea Excretion Index

Fractional Exhaled Nitric Oxide

A breath test that estimates type 2, often eosinophilic, airway inflammation. The result is interpreted with symptoms, age, treatment, and other clinical findings.

Alternate Names:
Exhaled NO Marker

Fractional Flow Reserve

A pressure measurement made during coronary angiography to determine whether a narrowed heart artery significantly limits blood flow. The result helps guide decisions about stents or medical treat-

ment.

Fractional IPV

A smaller-than-usual dose of inactivated polio vaccine given into the skin rather than the muscle. When used in an approved schedule, it helps protect against polio; the number of doses and timing follow local immunization guidance.

Fractional Shortening

An echocardiographic measurement of left ventricular systolic contractile function representing the percentage change in the left ventricular internal diameter between end-diastole (LVIDd) and end-systole (LVIDs). Calculated as the difference divided by end-diastolic diameter multiplied by 100 percent, with normal values typically ranging from 25 to 45 percent.

Alternate Names:
LV Fractional Shortening; FS

Fracture

A structural discontinuity, crack, or complete disruption in the mechanical continuity of a bone or cartilage, resulting from mechanical forces that exceed the bone's structural strength. Classified by relationship to external skin into closed (simple) and open (compound, communicating with the external environment with elevated infection and osteomyelitis risks); by mechanical configuration into transverse, oblique, spiral, comminuted (more than two fragments), segmental, avulsion, impacted, or greenstick/torus (incomplete fractures in pediatric bone); and by underlying bone integrity into traumatic fractures, stress fractures (microfractures from repetitive submaximal loading), and pathologic fractures (occurring in bone weakened by pre-existing disease such as osteoporosis, osteolytic metastases, or multiple myeloma). In children, fractures involving the cartilaginous growth plate are classified by the Salter-Harris system (types I–V). Clinical features include acute pain, localized tenderness, swelling, ecchymosis, deformity, crepitus, and functional loss. Management centers on the "4 Rs": resuscitation, reduction (closed or open reduction), retention/stabilization (casting, splinting, external fixation, or internal fixation [ORIF]), and rehabilitation.

Alternate Names:
Fractures; Bone Fracture

Fractured Clavicle In The Newborn

A broken collarbone in a newborn, usually related to birth stress. The baby may move one arm less or cry when handled; most heal well with gentle support and follow-up.

Fractured Elbow

A break involving one of the bones forming the elbow. It can cause pain, swelling, deformity, and limited movement and may injure nearby nerves or blood vessels.

Fractured Ilium

A break in the broad upper part of the pelvic bone, usually from major trauma or weakened bone. It may cause severe pain and can accompany injury to pelvic organs or blood vessels.

Fracture Displacement

Movement of broken bone pieces out of their normal alignment, including sideways shift, angling, shortening, or rotation. The need for reduction or surgery depends on the bone, joint involvement, age, and function.

Fractured Nose

A break in the nasal bones or supporting cartilage, usually after a blow. Pain, swelling, bleeding, and deformity may occur; a collection of blood inside the septum can damage cartilage.

Alternate Names:
Nasal Bone Fracture

Fractured Rib

A break in one or more ribs, usually from injury or forceful coughing. Sharp pain worsens with breathing or movement; significant trauma can also cause lung collapse, bleeding, or injury to nearby organs.

Alternate Names:
Costal Fracture; Broken Ribs

Fracture Fixation

Stabilization of a broken bone with a cast, splint, plate, screw, nail, wire, or external frame. The goal is to maintain alignment while the bone heals and, when possible, preserve movement.

Fracture-Fixation Device

A plate, screw, rod, pin, wire, or external frame used to hold broken bone pieces in alignment during healing. Choice depends on the fracture, bone quality, soft-tissue injury, and expected movement.

Fracture Liaison Service

A coordinated healthcare program for people with fragility fractures. It evaluates bone strength and underlying causes, arranges treatment and fall prevention, and follows patients to reduce future fractures.

Fracture Malunion

Healing of a broken bone in an incorrect position, such as with angling, shortening, or rotation. It may cause deformity, pain, weakness, altered movement, or abnormal stress on nearby joints.

Fracture Nonunion

Failure of a broken bone to heal within the expected time, with no continuing progress toward healing. Pain, movement at the fracture site, or persistent weakness may occur, and causes include poor blood supply, infection, instability, and smoking.

Fracture Of The Temporal Bone

A break in a skull bone containing parts of the ear and nearby nerves and blood vessels. It may cause hearing loss, dizziness, facial weakness, bleeding, or leakage of brain fluid.

Fracture Prevention

Measures that lower the chance of broken bones, including treating osteoporosis, improving strength and balance, preventing falls, correcting vitamin or mineral deficiency, and reviewing medicines that increase risk.

Fracture Reduction

The realignment of broken bone fragments back into normal anatomical position, performed either non-surgically (closed reduction) or surgically (open reduction); see *Closed Reduction Of A Fractured Bone* and *Open Reduction and Internal Fixation*.

Fractures

Plural form; see *Fracture*.

Fragile X-Associated Tremor/Ataxia Syndrome

A late-onset progressive neurodegenerative disorder affecting premutation carriers (55 to 200 CGG repeats) of the *FMR1* gene, typically manifesting in men older than fifty years. Characterized by progressive intention tremor, cerebellar gait ataxia, parkinsonism, cognitive executive decline, and symmetric hyperintensities of the middle cerebellar peduncles ("MCP sign") on T2-weighted MRI.

Alternate Names:
FXTAS

Fragile X Syndrome

An X-linked inherited condition caused by a CGG-repeat expansion in the *FMR1* gene. It can affect learning, speech, behavior, social development, and physical features and is a common inherited cause of intellectual disability; expression varies because of repeat size, methylation, and sex.

FRAIL Scale

A brief questionnaire assessing fatigue, ability to climb stairs, walking ability, illness burden, and unintentional weight loss. It screens for frailty risk but does not replace a complete medical and functional assessment.

Frailty

A state of reduced physical reserve that makes an older or seriously ill person more vulnerable to falls, infection, hospitalization, disability, and other stress. Signs include weakness, slow walking, exhaustion, inactivity, and unintentional weight loss.

Frambesia

Alternate name; see *Yaws*.

Framboesia

Alternate spelling; see *Yaws*.

Frameshift Mutation

A genetic change caused by inserting or deleting DNA bases in numbers that are not multiples of three. This shifts how the genetic code is read and often produces a severely altered or nonworking protein.

Framycetin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic applied to selected bacterial skin, ear, or eye infections. It can cause local allergy or irritation; prolonged or extensive use may allow absorption and antibiotic-related toxicity.

Francisella

A group of small bacteria that includes Francisella tularensis, which causes tularemia. People can acquire infection through ticks, animals, contaminated water, food, or inhaled particles.

Francisellaceae

A family of small bacteria that includes Francisella species. Some cause tularemia or related infections in animals and people; disease type depends on the species and route of exposure.

Francisella Tularensis

A bacterium that causes tularemia, usually acquired through ticks, deer flies, infected animals, contaminated water or food, or inhalation. It can cause fever, an ulcer with swollen lymph nodes, pneumonia, or severe systemic illness.

Francois Dyscephaly Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Hallermann's Syndrome*.

Frank Breech

The most common breech presentation (accounting for 50–70% of all breech births), in which the fetus is positioned with hips flexed and knees extended so that the feet lie near the head and the buttocks present first to the birth canal. Compared to complete or footling breech, it has the lowest risk of umbilical cord prolapse.

Alternate Names:
Extended breech; Frank breech presentation.

Frank Haemoptysis

Alternate form; see *Haemoptysis*.

Frank Sign

A diagonal crease across the earlobe, sometimes called diagonal earlobe crease. It has been studied for a possible association with coronary artery disease, but its diagnostic accuracy is limited.

Alternate Names:
Frank's Sign; Diagonal Earlobe Crease

Frank-Starling Law

Within limits, greater filling of the heart's main pumping chambers stretches heart muscle and increases the force of contraction and the amount of blood pumped. This helps the heart match its output to the blood returning to it; excessive filling does not keep increasing output.

Alternate Names:
Starling Law of the Heart; Heterometric Autoregulation

Frank-Starling Mechanism

The heart normally contracts more strongly when its chambers fill with more blood, up to a limit. This helps match the amount pumped with the amount returning to the heart.

Fraser Syndrome

A rare congenital malformation syndrome, usually inherited in an autosomal recessive pattern, characterized by cryptophthalmos (skin covering part or all of an eye), syndactyly, and abnormalities of the urinary or genital tract. Respiratory, ear, nose, and skeletal anomalies may also occur. The features and severity vary, and some affected pregnancies end in fetal or neonatal death.

Alternate Names:

Cryptophthalmos Syndrome; Cryptophthalmos-Syndactyly Syndrome

Frasier Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder caused by changes in the WT1 gene. It can cause abnormal sexual development, progressive kidney disease, and increased risk of tumors in the gonads.

Fraternal Twins

Twins formed when two separate eggs are fertilized by two separate sperm. They are genetically like ordinary siblings and may be the same or different sex.

FRAXA

Alternate genetic name; see *Fragile X Syndrome*.

FRAX Tool

A calculator estimating a person's ten-year probability of a major osteoporosis-related fracture or hip fracture. It uses factors such as age, sex, bone density, previous fracture, and other risks and supports treatment decisions.

Alternate Names:
FRAX Fracture-Risk Calculator

Freckle

A small, flat, light brown or tan spot that develops on sun-exposed areas of the skin, such as the face, neck, and arms. Freckles are caused by an increased production of melanin pigment by normal skin cells in response to ultraviolet (UV) sunlight exposure, and they are particularly common in fair-skinned individuals with red or blond hair.

Alternate Names:
Freckles; Ephelis; Ephelides

Freckles

Plural form; see *Freckle*.

Free Fragment

A piece of spinal-disc material that has broken away from the main disc and may press on a nearby nerve. It can cause back or leg pain, numbness, weakness, or bladder and bowel problems.

Alternate Names:
Sequestered Disc Fragment; Extruded Herniated Fragment

Free Radical

A highly reactive molecule with an unpaired electron. The body makes some during normal metabolism, while excessive amounts can damage cell membranes, proteins, and DNA as part of oxidative stress.

Free Radical Injury

Cell damage caused by free radicals, highly reactive molecules that can alter cell-membrane fats, proteins, and DNA. It occurs when radical production exceeds the cell's antioxidant defenses and can contribute to tissue damage during inflammation or restoration of blood flow after ischemia.

Free T4 Test

A blood test measuring unbound thyroxine, the thyroid hormone available to tissues. It is usually interpreted with thyroid-stimulating hormone to assess overactive or underactive thyroid function and treatment response.

Free Thyroxine Index

A calculated estimate of the thyroid hormone available to tissues, using total thyroxine and a measure of hormone binding. It can help assess thyroid function when binding-protein levels affect total hormone results.

Free Tissue Transfer

Microsurgical transplantation of tissue, such as skin, fat, muscle, bone, or a combination, from one part of the body to another. The transferred tissue is reconnected to local blood vessels, and sometimes nerves, to reconstruct a complex defect after trauma, cancer treatment, burns, or congenital difference.

Free Water Clearance

A kidney measurement showing whether urine contains more or less water than blood plasma. Positive values indicate excretion of dilute urine; negative values indicate water retention and concentrated

urine.

Freeze Drying

A preservation process that freezes material and removes ice under low pressure. It helps preserve medicines, vaccines, biological samples, and foods while limiting damage from heat and moisture.

Freezing

Exposure to very low temperature that can freeze tissue, cause frostbite, or dangerously lower body temperature. The term also describes preserving food, medicines, or samples by storing them at low temperature.

Freiberg Disease

An idiopathic avascular necrosis (osteochondrosis) affecting the head of a metatarsal bone (most commonly the second metatarsal head), typically occurring in adolescent and young adult females, presenting with forefoot pain and stiffness exacerbated by weight-bearing.

Alternate Names:
Freiberg Infraction; Metatarsal Head Osteochondrosis

Fremitus

A vibration felt or heard through body tissues. During a chest examination, transmitted voice vibrations can change with fluid, air, or solid tissue in or around the lungs.

French Disease

An old name for syphilis, a sexually transmitted infection caused by Treponema pallidum. Untreated infection can progress from sores to widespread disease and later damage the brain, nerves, heart, or other organs.

Frenectomy

A procedure that removes or releases a frenulum, a fold of tissue that may restrict tongue movement, pull on the gums, separate teeth, or interfere with dentures. Bleeding, infection, and scarring are possible.

Frenulum

A fold of skin or mucous membrane that anchors a body part and limits its movement. Examples include the tongue fold, lip folds, and penile frenulum.

Frenulum Breve

An abnormally short penile frenulum that may cause pain, tearing, or bleeding during erection or sexual activity. Treatment depends on symptoms and may include observation or a minor surgical procedure.

Frenum

Alternate name; see *Frenulum*.

Frequency

Urinating more often than usual, sometimes with only small amounts passed. It differs from producing a large total urine volume and may result from infection, pregnancy, diabetes, medicines, or bladder disorders.

Frequency Of Urination

Alternate name; see *Frequency*.

Frequency Range

The lowest to highest sound or signal frequencies that a device can detect, produce, or amplify effectively. In hearing care, it helps describe which pitches a hearing aid can process.

Frequency Response

How strongly a device or body system responds to different sound or signal frequencies. In a hearing aid, it describes the amount of amplification provided for low, middle, and high pitches.

Frequent Bowel Movements

Passing stool more often than is usual for a person. Causes include diet, infection, medicines, inflammation, poor absorption, or functional bowel disorders; blood, fever, dehydration, or weight loss may accompany more serious causes.

Frequent Or Urgent Urination

Urinating often or having sudden urges that are difficult to postpone. Infection, bladder irritation, diabetes, pregnancy, medicines, obstruction, or overactive bladder can cause these symptoms.

Frequent Urination

Alternate name; see *Frequency*.

Fresh Frozen Plasma

Plasma separated from whole blood or collected by apheresis and frozen within the specified time after collection, usually 8 hours. It contains coagulation factors and other plasma proteins and is transfused to replace multiple deficient factors.

Alternate Names:
FFP

Fresh Specimen

A recently collected biological sample tested promptly or preserved correctly before changes affect its cells, organisms, chemistry, or diagnostic accuracy.

Frey'S Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Frey Syndrome*.

Frey Syndrome

An abnormal gustatory sweating and facial flushing over the parotid and preauricular region occurring in response to mastication or tasting food, caused by aberrant misdirected regeneration of severed parasympathetic secretomotor fibers of the auriculotemporal nerve into sympathetic sweat glands following parotid gland surgery or trauma.

Alternate Names:
Auriculotemporal Syndrome; Gustatory Sweating

Friable

Describes tissue that is unusually soft, fragile, and easily torn. Friable tissue may bleed readily when touched and can occur with inflammation, infection, cancer, or poor healing.

Friction

Rubbing between surfaces. Skin friction can cause irritation, blisters, or sores; reducing moisture, pressure, and rubbing helps prevent injury.

Friction Blisters

Fluid-filled blisters caused by repeated rubbing or pressure, commonly on the feet or hands. Reduced friction and wound cleanliness support healing; extensive, infected, or recurrent blisters may have complications.

Friedlander Pneumonia

An older name for pneumonia caused by *Klebsiella pneumoniae*. It can cause fever, cough, chest pain, and thick, blood-tinged sputum, especially in people with underlying illness; the organism can also cause other types of infection.

Friedman Curve

An older graph describing cervical opening over time during labor. Modern labor care recognizes wider normal variation and does not use this historical curve alone to diagnose slow labor or decide on intervention.

Friedreich Ataxia

An inherited disorder that progressively damages nerves and coordination. It can cause unsteady walking, weakness, reduced sensation, spinal curvature, heart muscle disease, and sometimes diabetes.

Friedreich's Ataxia

Alternate spelling; see *Friedreich Ataxia*.

Friedreichs Ataxia Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Friedreich Ataxia*.

Froin Syndrome

The triad of clear xanthochromia, elevated protein content, and rapid spontaneous clotting of cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) obtained below a complete anatomical obstruction of the spinal subarachnoid space (e.g., from a compressive spinal cord tumor or severe spinal stenosis).

Alternate Names:
Froin's Syndrome; Spinal Subarachnoid Blockade Syndrome

Froment Sign

A clinical sign of ulnar nerve palsy; when attempting to firmly pinch a piece of paper between the thumb and index finger, paralysis of the adductor pollicis forces the patient to compensate by flexing the interphalangeal joint of the thumb using the flexor pollicis longus (innervated by the anterior interosseous nerve).

Alternate Names:
Froment's Paper Sign; Ulnar Pinch Sign

Frontal

Relating to the forehead, frontal skull bone, or frontal lobe of the brain. The frontal lobe helps control voluntary movement, planning, attention, speech, behavior, and decision-making.

Frontal Bone

The skull bone forming the forehead, roof of the eye sockets, and part of the nasal region. It contains the frontal sinuses and protects the front of the brain.

Frontal Bossing

An unusually prominent forehead caused by forward bulging of the frontal skull bones. It may be familial or associated with bone disease, excess pressure in the skull, or skeletal disorders.

Frontalis Suspension

An operation connecting the upper eyelid to the forehead muscle with a sling to lift a drooping eyelid. It is used when the eyelid-lifting muscle is weak, especially in congenital or childhood ptosis.

Frontal Lobe

The front portion of the brain's outer layer. It helps control movement, planning, attention, judgment, behavior, personality, and speech production in the language-dominant hemisphere.

Frontal Lobe Disorder

A condition affecting brain areas involved in planning, judgment, movement, attention, speech, and behavior. Causes include stroke, injury, tumor, dementia, infection, or other neurologic disease.

Frontal Lobe Epilepsy

Epilepsy caused by seizures beginning in the frontal lobe. Episodes may involve sudden movements, unusual behavior, impaired awareness, or events during sleep and can be difficult to distinguish from sleep disorders.

Alternate Names:
FLE; Frontal Lobe Epilepsy Syndrome

Frontal Lobe Seizures

Seizures beginning in the front part of the brain, often causing brief unusual movements, behaviors, sensations, speech changes, or impaired awareness. Symptoms depend on the exact brain area involved.

Alternate Names:
Frontal Lobe Ictal Episodes

Frontal Lobe Syndrome

A clinical neuropsychiatric disorder resulting from traumatic, ischemic, or neurodegenerative injury to the frontal lobes, manifesting as executive dysfunction, behavioral disinhibition, apathy, abulia, impaired social judgment, utilization behavior, and loss of emotional control.

Alternate Names:
Frontal Dysexecutive Syndrome

Frontal Sinus

An air-filled cavity within the frontal skull bone above the eye. It connects with the nasal passages and can become inflamed or blocked during sinusitis.

Frontal Sinusitis

Inflammation of the air-filled cavities above the eyes, usually from a viral infection or blocked drainage. It can cause forehead pain, congestion, and discharge; severe headache, eye swelling, fever, confusion, or neurologic symptoms may indicate complications.

Frontotemporal Dementia

A group of progressive brain disorders affecting the frontal and temporal lobes. Early changes often involve personality, behavior, judgment, language, or movement rather than memory alone.

Alternate Names:
FTD; Pick Complex; Behavioral Variant FTD

Frontotemporal Lobar Degeneration

Progressive loss of nerve cells in the frontal and temporal brain regions. It can cause early changes in behavior, personality, language, judgment, or movement and may occur at a relatively young age.

Frostbite

A freezing injury to the skin and deeper tissues that can cause numbness, pale or waxy skin, swelling, blisters, and tissue death.

Frotteuristic Disorder

A mental disorder involving persistent sexual arousal from touching or rubbing against a person without consent, with clinically significant distress or impairment or acting on the urges. Nonconsensual touching is sexual assault.

Frozen Section

A rapid tissue examination performed during surgery. A specimen is frozen, cut into thin slices, and examined to provide immediate information about a lesion or surgical margin, although permanent sections are often more accurate.

Frozen Shoulder

A painful condition in which the shoulder capsule tightens, progressively limiting movement. The primary form is idiopathic; secondary cases are associated with conditions such as diabetes or thyroid disease, or prolonged immobility. It often improves slowly over months or years.

Alternate Names:
Adhesive Capsulitis; Periarthritis of Shoulder

Fructosamine

A blood measurement of sugar attached to blood proteins, reflecting average blood glucose over roughly the previous two to three weeks. It can help when the longer-term hemoglobin A1c test is unreliable.

Fructose

A natural sugar found in fruit, honey, some vegetables, and many sweetened foods. It is processed mainly by the liver; poor absorption can cause gas, bloating, cramps, or diarrhea after eating it.

Alternate Names:
Fruit Sugar; Levulose

Fructose-1,6-Bisphosphatase Deficiency

An inherited disorder of gluconeogenesis caused by deficient fructose-1,6-bisphosphatase. Fasting or illness can lead to low blood glucose, lactic acidosis, ketosis, vomiting, and marked weakness.

Fructose Intolerance

An ambiguous term used for two distinct disorders. Hereditary fructose intolerance is an inherited aldolase B deficiency that can cause hypoglycemia and liver injury after fructose exposure; fructose malabsorption is incomplete intestinal absorption that can cause gas, bloating, pain, or diarrhea.

Fructose Malabsorption

Incomplete absorption of fructose in the small intestine. Unabsorbed sugar is fermented by bacteria and can cause gas, bloating, cramps, or diarrhea; reducing personal dietary triggers may help.

Fructose Metabolism

The body's processing of fructose, mainly in the liver, into substances used for energy or stored. Rare enzyme defects can cause harmless fructose in urine or serious low blood sugar and liver injury after intake.

Fruity Breath

A sweet, acetone-like breath odor caused by ketones. In someone with diabetes, especially with high glucose, vomiting, abdominal pain, deep breathing, or confusion, it may signal life-threatening ketoacidosis.

Frustration

An emotional response to blocked goals, unmet needs, or difficult circumstances. It may cause irritability, anger, distress, withdrawal, or behavior changes and becomes clinically important when persistent or impairing.

Fryns Syndrome

A rare inherited condition present from birth, often involving a hole in the diaphragm, characteristic facial features, and abnormal fingers or toes. Brain, heart, kidney, or genital abnormalities may also occur.

FSH

Abbreviation; see *Follicle-Stimulating Hormone*.

Ft.

An abbreviation for foot or feet, a length of 12 inches or about 30.48 centimeters. In medical records, context distinguishes it from other abbreviations.

FTA-ABS Blood Test

A blood test detecting antibodies against Treponema pallidum, the bacterium that causes syphilis. It supports diagnosis but often stays positive after treatment and cannot by itself show whether infection is active.

FTA-ABS Test

Alternate name; see *FTA-ABS Blood Test*.

Fuchs' Dystrophy

A usually inherited disease in which cells lining the inside of the cornea gradually stop removing fluid. The cornea can swell and become cloudy, causing blurred vision, glare, or light sensitivity, often worse in the morning. It usually affects both eyes; advanced disease can cause painful blisters and vision loss.

Alternate Names:
Fuchs Dystrophy; Fuchs Corneal Dystrophy

Fuchs Endothelial Corneal Dystrophy

Alternate name; see *Fuchs' Dystrophy*.

Fuchs Endothelial Dystrophy

Alternate name; see *Fuchs' Dystrophy*.

Fucose

A sugar found in some cell-surface proteins and fats. It helps cells recognize and attach to one another and participates in immune signaling and other biological processes.

Fucosidosis

A rare inherited disorder in which cells cannot break down certain sugar-containing substances. Their buildup progressively affects development, movement, bones, growth, sweating, and organ function.

Fucosyltransferase

An enzyme that attaches the sugar fucose to proteins or fats. This changes how cells recognize one another, develop, interact with microbes, and display some blood-group markers.

Fuel Oil Poisoning

Illness after swallowing, inhaling, or having fuel oil on the skin. Inhalation can damage the lungs and cause coughing or breathing difficulty.

Fugue

A rare dissociative state involving unexpected travel or wandering with loss of memory about personal identity or the past. It may be associated with trauma, mental illness, substances, neurologic disease, or safety risks.

Fukuda Stepping Test

A bedside vestibular test in which a person marches in place with eyes closed while an examiner observes turning or displacement. Results vary, and the test has limited diagnostic accuracy; rotation alone cannot reliably confirm or localize one-sided vestibular loss.

Alternate Names:
Unterberger-Fukuda Test; Vestibular Stepping Test

Fukuyama Congenital Muscular

Dystrophy

A rare inherited muscle disorder beginning in infancy, causing low muscle tone, weakness, contractures, and delayed development. Abnormalities of the brain and eyes, seizures, and heart disease may also occur.

Alternate Names:
FCMD; Fukuyama Type Congenital Muscular Dystrophy

Fulguration

Destruction or sealing of tissue using electrical energy during a procedure. It may control bleeding or treat selected abnormal tissue, but nearby tissue can be burned or injured.

Full Agonist

A medicine or chemical that binds to a cell receptor and produces the strongest response that receptor can generate. The actual effect still depends on dose, receptor number, tissue, and individual response.

Full Blood Count

See *Complete Blood Count*.

Alternate Names:
FBC; Complete Blood Count (CBC)

Full Liquid Diet

A diet containing liquids and foods that become liquid at room temperature, such as milk, strained soups, yogurt, and custard. It may be used temporarily, but prolonged use can lack fiber and some nutrients.

Full Sibling

A person who shares both biological parents with another person. This relationship is relevant to family medical history, genetic-risk assessment, and some tissue or organ-donor matching.

Full-Thickness Skin Graft

A graft containing the outer skin layer and the entire dermis, moved to cover a wound or reconstruct a defect. It usually gives durable coverage but requires a suitable donor site and blood supply.

Fulminant

Beginning suddenly and becoming severe very quickly. The term describes a dangerous pattern of illness, such as rapidly progressive liver failure, infection, or inflammation.

Fulminant Hepatitis

Rapid, severe liver injury causing loss of liver function, abnormal bleeding, and sometimes confusion or coma from toxin buildup. It is a medical emergency that may require intensive care and liver transplantation.

Fulminant Myocarditis

Sudden, severe inflammation of the heart muscle causing poor pumping, dangerous rhythms, or shock. It requires intensive care and treatment of the cause and complications; temporary mechanical heart support may be needed.

Fulminating Hyperpyrexia

Alternate name; see *Malignant Hyperthermia*.

Fulvestrant

An injectable hormone treatment that blocks and helps destroy estrogen receptors in selected hormone-sensitive breast cancers. It can cause injection-site pain, hot flushes, joint symptoms, fatigue, and liver-test changes.

Fumigation

Treating an enclosed area with gas, vapor, or smoke to kill pests or microorganisms. The process requires evacuation of people and animals and adequate ventilation before re-entry.

Functional Asplenia

Poor or absent spleen function even though the spleen is present. It increases the risk of severe infections, especially from certain bacteria; prevention may include vaccination and, in selected cases, preventive antibiotics.

Functional Assessment

Evaluation of how well a person moves, commu-

nicates, thinks, and performs daily activities. It identifies support needs, tracks change, guides rehabilitation, and helps plan safe care.

Functional Capacity

The level of physical, mental, communication, and self-care activity a person can safely perform under particular conditions. It depends on health, environment, assistance, and personal goals.

Functional Constipation

Long-lasting constipation without an identified blockage or other clear disease causing it. Stools may be hard or difficult to pass, or a person may feel that the bowel has not emptied fully. It may be related to diet, low fluid intake, inactivity, or regularly ignoring the urge to pass stool.

Functional Decline

A reduction in a person's ability to move, think, communicate, or perform daily activities compared with their previous level. In older adults it may result from illness, medicines, hospitalization, pain, poor nutrition, or lack of activity.

Functional Diarrhea

Long-lasting loose or watery stools without an identified infection or other clear disease causing them. Unlike irritable bowel syndrome, belly pain is not the main symptom. Diet, medicines, stress, and changes in bowel movement can contribute.

Functional Disorder

A condition in which symptoms or impaired body function arise from altered processing or regulation without a structural abnormality sufficient to explain them. The symptoms are real and can cause substantial disability.

Functional Dyspepsia

Repeated upper-abdominal discomfort without a clear structural cause. It may cause pain or burning in the upper middle abdomen, uncomfortable fullness after meals, or feeling full too soon while eating. Signals between the gut and brain may affect how the stomach senses and moves food.

Alternate Names:
Nonulcer Dyspepsia (older term)

Functional Electrical Stimulation

Electrical impulses applied to nerves or muscles to produce a useful movement, such as lifting the foot during walking. It may assist rehabilitation after stroke, spinal injury, or other nerve damage.

Functional Endoscopic Sinus Surgery

Surgery performed through the nostrils using a small camera and instruments to open blocked sinus passages or remove tissue such as nasal polyps. It may be used for selected long-lasting sinus problems. Bleeding, infection, or injury to nearby structures can occur.

Alternate Names:
FESS; Endoscopic Sinus Surgery; ESS; Functional Sinus Surgery

Functional Gastrointestinal Disorders

Digestive symptoms caused by altered gut movement or sensitivity without an obvious structural disease. Symptoms may include pain, bloating, constipation, diarrhea, nausea, or early fullness.

Alternate Names:
Disorders of Gut-Brain Interaction; FGIDs

Functional Hypothalamic Amenorrhea

Missing menstrual periods because stress, inadequate energy intake, excessive exercise, or disordered eating suppresses reproductive hormones. It can lower estrogen, impair fertility, and weaken bones, but often improves when the underlying imbalance is corrected.

Alternate Names:
Hypothalamic Amenorrhea; FHA

Functional Impairment

Difficulty performing usual work, study, self-care, relationships, or other daily activities because of symptoms, illness, injury, or treatment. The degree of impairment is considered separately from the diagnosis and may change over time.

Functional Incontinence

Urine leakage because a person cannot reach, recognize, or use the toilet in time, even when bladder storage may be adequate. Mobility, memory, vision, clothing, communication, or environmental barriers may contribute.

Functional Independence Measure

A structured tool that rates how much help a person needs with self-care, toileting, transfers, walking, communication, and thinking. It is used mainly in rehabilitation to track function and progress.

Functional MRI

A magnetic-resonance scan that estimates brain activity from changes in blood flow and oxygen use. It can map language or movement areas before selected brain procedures and does not use X-ray radiation.

Functional Murmur

A heart murmur produced by turbulent or accelerated blood flow without structural heart disease. It may become audible during states that increase cardiac output, such as fever, anemia, pregnancy, or exercise. A murmur is a flow sound, distinct from additional heart sounds such as S3 or S4.

Functional Neurological Disorder

Alternate name; see *Functional Neurologic Disorder*.

Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder

Alternate name; see *Functional Neurologic Disorder*.

Functional Neurologic Disorder

A condition in which changes in how the brain and nervous system function cause real symptoms, such as weakness, abnormal movements, seizures, or altered sensation. Diagnosis is based on specific examination findings, not simply on the absence of another disease.

Alternate Names:
FND; Conversion Disorder (historical term); Functional Neurological Symptom Disorder

Functional Neurologic Disorder/Conversion Disorder

Alternate name; see *Functional Neurologic Disorder*.

Functional Ovarian Cysts

Ovarian cysts related to the normal menstrual cycle, usually a follicular cyst or corpus-luteum cyst. They commonly resolve without treatment but may cause pain, bleeding, rupture, or ovarian torsion.

Functional Residual Capacity

The amount of air left in the lungs after a normal relaxed breath out. It helps keep air sacs open and may be reduced by obesity or restrictive lung disease or increased by air trapping.

Functional Screening

A brief check of a person's ability to move safely, communicate, perform daily activities, and manage basic self-care. Abnormal results may lead to a fuller medical, occupational, or rehabilitation assessment.

Functional Status

A person's ability to manage daily activities such as bathing, dressing, eating, toileting, walking, shopping, cooking, medicines, finances, and transportation. Decline may signal illness or a need for support.

Functional Urinary Incontinence

Urine leakage that happens because a person cannot reach, recognize, or use the toilet in time, even when the bladder may work normally. Problems with walking, memory, vision, clothing, communication, or the environment can contribute; treatment addresses these barriers and other causes of leakage.

Functioning Carcinoid

A carcinoid neuroendocrine tumor that releases hormones or other active substances in amounts that cause clinical symptoms. Not all carcinoid tumors are functioning.

Fundal Height

The distance from the pubic bone to the top of

the uterus, measured during pregnancy. It roughly follows weeks of pregnancy after about 20 weeks; differences may reflect dating error, growth problems, twins, or fluid changes.

Fundoplication

Surgery that wraps the upper stomach around the lower esophagus to strengthen the valve and reduce acid reflux. It may also repair a hiatal hernia; swallowing difficulty, gas, or recurrent reflux can occur afterward.

Fundoscopy

Examination of the back of the eye using an ophthalmoscope or camera. It views the retina, optic nerve, macula, and blood vessels to assess conditions such as diabetes, high blood pressure, or retinal disease.

Fundus

The rounded or farthest part of a hollow organ. Examples include the upper part of the stomach, the top of the uterus, and the inside back surface of the eye.

Fundus Oculi

The inside back surface of the eye visible through the pupil. It includes the retina, optic nerve, macula, and retinal blood vessels.

Fundus Photography

Photographing the back of the eye to record the retina, optic nerve, macula, and blood vessels. Images help detect and monitor retinal disease and allow comparison over time.

Fundus Uteri

The rounded upper part of the uterus above the openings of the fallopian tubes. Its position and size can be assessed during pelvic examination and pregnancy.

Fungal

Relating to fungi or caused by a fungus. Fungal infections may affect the skin, nails, mouth, lungs, bloodstream, or other organs.

Fungal Arthritis

A fungal infection inside a joint, usually after surgery, injury, injection, bloodstream spread, or with weakened immunity. It often develops slowly with persistent pain, swelling, and reduced movement and may need prolonged treatment and surgery.

Fungal Corneal Ulcer

A serious fungal infection and open sore on the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It may follow an injury involving plant material, contaminated contact lenses, or prolonged steroid eye-drop use. Severe pain, redness, light sensitivity, blurred vision, or a cloudy spot may occur. Eye examination and testing of a corneal sample can support the diagnosis; delayed treatment can threaten vision.

Alternate Names:
Fungal Keratitis; Keratomycosis; Mycotic Corneal Ulcer

Fungal Endophthalmitis

A fungal infection inside the eye, often after bloodstream infection, surgery, injury, or weakened immunity. It can rapidly damage vision; treatment includes antifungal medicine and sometimes surgery.

Fungal Ear Infection

Alternate name; see *Otomycosis*.

Fungal Infection

An illness caused by a fungus, such as a yeast or mold. It may affect the skin, nails, or moist body surfaces, or spread to organs such as the lungs or brain. The type and severity depend on the fungus and the part of the body affected; serious invasive infections are more common when immune defenses are weakened.

Alternate Names:
Mycosis; Mycotic Infection; Fungal Disease

Fungal Nail Infection

A fungal infection of a fingernail or toenail causing thickening, discoloration, brittleness, or separation from the nail bed. Diagnosis may require testing because injury and skin disease can look similar.

Alternate Names:
Onychomycosis; Tinea Unguium; Nail Mycosis

Fungal Nail Infections

Alternate name; see *Fungal Nail Infection*.

Fungal Nails

Alternate name; see *Fungal Nail Infection*.

Fungal Pathogenesis

The ways fungi cause disease, including attaching to cells, growing into tissue, avoiding immune defenses, and releasing damaging substances. The process varies with the fungus, body site, and person's immunity.

Fungal Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by fungi, including endemic fungi, Aspergillus, Pneumocystis, and other opportunistic organisms. Risk depends on geography, immune status, neutropenia, transplantation, and inhaled exposures; diagnosis may require cultures, antigen or molecular tests, imaging, and bronchoscopy.

Fungal Sinusitis

A group of conditions in which fungi affect the nasal and sinus cavities. Forms range from noninvasive fungal growth or fungus-triggered allergic inflammation to invasive infection that damages tissue, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Alternate Names:
Fungal Rhinosinusitis

Fungal Resistance Mechanisms

Changes that allow fungi to survive antifungal medicines, such as altering a drug target, pumping medicine out of the cell, or changing cell-wall production. Resistance can make infections harder to treat.

Fungal Skin Infections

Infections of the skin caused by dermatophytes or yeasts, including ringworm, athlete's foot, and candidiasis. They often cause red, itchy, scaly, or ring-shaped areas and thrive in warm, moist conditions.

Fungating

Describing a mass or wound that grows outward with an irregular, ulcerated, dead, or foul-smelling surface. It may occur with advanced cancer or severe chronic wounds and can bleed, leak, and become infected.

Fungemia

The presence of living fungi in the bloodstream, most often Candida in hospitalized patients. It can spread to organs; treatment includes antifungal medicines and management of the infection source.

Fungi

Organisms including yeasts, molds, and mushrooms. Some live harmlessly in the environment or body, while others cause infections of the skin, mouth, lungs, bloodstream, or other organs.

Fungicide

A chemical used to kill or inhibit fungi. Some fungicides are used on crops or surfaces, while selected medicines act against fungi in people; toxicity depends on the substance and exposure.

Fungoid

Resembling a fungus or mushroom in appearance. In medicine it may describe an outward-growing, irregular lesion or mass, but appearance alone does not establish its cause.

Fungus

A type of organism including yeasts and molds, with distinctive cell walls and membranes. Fungi reproduce in various ways and can cause superficial or invasive infection, especially when immunity is weakened.

Funiculus

A cord-like bundle of nerve fibers or other structures. In the spinal cord, a funiculus contains nerve pathways; in the spermatic cord, it is the bundle carrying the vas deferens, blood vessels, nerves, and

lymph vessels.

Funisitis

Inflammation of the umbilical cord, usually associated with infection or inflammation of the membranes around the fetus. It may increase newborn infection risk.

Funnel Chest

Alternate name; see *Pectus Excavatum*.

Funnel-Web Spider Bite

A potentially life-threatening bite from a funnel-web spider. Venom may cause pain, sweating, tingling, muscle spasms, breathing difficulty, or collapse; first aid commonly includes keeping the person still and pressure immobilization.

Furan

A chemical compound used in manufacturing and found in small amounts in some heated foods. High or repeated exposure may harm the liver and other organs.

Furocoumarin

A plant chemical found in some citrus and other plants that can make skin unusually sensitive to ultraviolet light. Contact followed by sunlight may cause redness, blistering, or dark pigmentation.

Furrowed Tongue

Alternate name; see *Fissured Tongue*.

Fursultiamin

A fat-soluble form of thiamine, or vitamin B1, used in some countries as a vitamin preparation. Its clinical value and safety depend on the indication, dose, and other medicines.

Furuncle

A painful, pus-filled infection of a hair follicle, usually caused by Staphylococcus aureus. It forms a red lump and may drain; lesions may be larger, recurrent, facial, or associated with fever.

Furuncle And Carbuncle

A furuncle is a deep infected hair follicle, or boil. A carbuncle is a connected group of boils forming a larger, deeper infection; both may require drainage and sometimes antibiotics.

Furuncular Myiasis

A fly-larva infestation forming a boil-like skin lump with a central opening through which the larva breathes. It may cause pain, movement sensations, or drainage and requires safe removal.

Furunculosis

Repeated or multiple boils caused by infection of hair follicles, often with Staphylococcus aureus. Risk factors include close contact, skin disease, diabetes, and weakened immunity; treatment may involve drainage or antibiotics.

Fusariosis

An opportunistic infection caused by Fusarium fungi, mainly affecting people with severely weakened immunity or prolonged low neutrophil counts. It can cause skin lesions, bloodstream infection, pneumonia, and disease in multiple organs.

Fusarium

A group of environmental molds that can cause nail, eye, skin, sinus, lung, or widespread infections. Severe disease occurs mainly in people with weakened immunity, especially prolonged neutropenia.

Fusarium Infection

An infection caused by Fusarium molds, which may affect the nails, eyes, skin, sinuses, lungs, or bloodstream. Invasive disease mainly affects people with severe immune suppression and is treated with antifungal medicines.

Fusarium Solani

An environmental mold that can cause eye, nail, skin, or invasive infections, especially in people with weakened immunity. Its clinical importance depends on the specimen, body site, symptoms, and laboratory confirmation.

Fused Placenta

A placenta in which areas that normally form separate lobes are joined. It is often an anatomical variation, but careful examination after delivery helps identify any retained placental tissue or abnormal blood vessels.

Fused Teeth

Alternate name; see *Fusion*.

Fusidic Acid

An antibiotic that blocks bacterial protein production and is used for selected staphylococcal infections. Resistance can develop, so it is often combined with another antibiotic and used according to local guidance.

Fusiform

Shaped like a spindle, wider in the middle and narrowing toward both ends. The term may describe a muscle, cell, swelling, or blood-vessel enlargement such as an aneurysm.

Fusiform Aneurysm

An aneurysm involving a relatively elongated, spindle-shaped expansion of the circumference of a blood vessel.

Fusion

Joining of two structures that are normally separate. It may describe bones, joints, teeth, organs, genes, or tissues and can occur naturally, during development, after injury, or through surgery.

Alternate Names:
Dental Fusion; Synodontia

Fusion Gene

A gene formed when parts of two separate genes become joined. It may produce an abnormal protein that drives some cancers and can sometimes be identified by genetic testing.

Fusion Of The Ear Bones

Abnormal joining or stiffening of the tiny middle-ear bones, which can reduce sound transmission and cause conductive hearing loss. Evaluation identifies the cause and whether surgery or hearing support may help.

Fusion Protein

A protein made when parts of two different proteins become joined, usually because their genes have fused. Some fusion proteins drive cancer; others are deliberately engineered for research or treatment.

Fusobacterium

A group of bacteria that grow without oxygen and commonly live in the mouth and intestine. Some species can cause dental, throat, abdominal, wound, bloodstream, or other invasive infections.

Fusobacterium Infection

Infection caused by Fusobacterium bacteria, which may spread from the mouth or intestine to the throat, lungs, abdomen, skin, joints, or bloodstream. Symptoms and treatment depend on the site and severity.

Fusobacterium Necrophorum

A bacterium that can cause severe throat infection and Lemierre syndrome, in which infection spreads to neck veins and may produce infected clots, lung complications, and bloodstream infection.

Fusobacterium Nucleatum

A common mouth bacterium associated with gum disease. It can occasionally cause bloodstream or other invasive infection and has also been studied for possible links with intestinal and pregnancy-related disease.

Fusospirochetal Gingivitis

A painful gum infection involving fusobacteria and spirochetes, causing bleeding, ulcers, swelling, and foul breath. It is associated with poor oral hygiene, stress, smoking, or illness and needs dental treatment.

G

G6PD Deficiency

An inherited condition in which red blood cells can break down after infections, fava beans, or certain medicines. Episodes may cause anemia, jaundice, fatigue, shortness of breath, or dark urine.

G6PD Deficiency in the Newborn

G6PD deficiency present at birth, often causing jaundice when red blood cells break down. Severe jaundice can harm the brain, so it is monitored and treated in affected newborns.

Gabapentin

A medicine used for certain seizures and nerve-related pain. It can cause sleepiness, dizziness, swelling, or impaired coordination; the dose often needs adjustment in kidney disease and stopping suddenly can cause problems.

GABA Receptor

A protein on nerve cells that responds to GABA, a chemical messenger that usually quiets nerve activity. These receptors help regulate sleep, anxiety, muscle control, and seizures and are targets of several medicines.

GAD

An abbreviation for generalized anxiety disorder, involving excessive, difficult-to-control worry about several areas of life for at least six months, with symptoms such as restlessness, tension, fatigue, poor concentration, or sleep disturbance.

Alternate Names:
Generalized Anxiety Disorder

Gadolinium

A metal used in chemically bound form in some MRI contrast agents. The risk of a serious reaction depends on the agent and the patient; certain agents can cause nephrogenic systemic fibrosis in people with severe kidney disease, and small amounts may remain in the body after repeated exposure.

Gadolinium-Based Contrast Agent

A contrast agent injected during some MRI scans to make organs, blood vessels, or abnormal tissue easier to see. Nephrogenic systemic fibrosis is a rare risk, greatest with certain older agents in people with acute kidney injury or severe chronic kidney disease; the risk is very low with current group II agents.

Gadolinium-Induced Nephrogenic Systemic Fibrosis

A rare disorder causing thickened, tight skin and sometimes internal-organ involvement after exposure to certain gadolinium-based MRI contrast agents, mainly in people with severe kidney impairment.

Gadopentetate Dimeglumine

A linear gadolinium-based contrast agent used for MRI. The American College of Radiology classifies it as a Group I agent, the group associated with the greatest number of nephrogenic systemic fibrosis cases; the risk is greatest in severe kidney impairment.

Gag Gene

A retroviral gene that encodes structural proteins

forming the virus's inner support, shell, and core. These proteins help assemble new virus particles inside infected cells.

Gagging

Retching caused by stimulation of the throat or back of the tongue. It may occur with swallowing difficulty, reflux, infection, examination, aspiration, or distress.

Gag Protein

A large retroviral protein that is cut into components forming the virus's inner support, protective shell, and genetic-material core. These parts are required to assemble new virus particles.

Gag Reflex

A protective response in which touching the back of the throat causes throat-muscle contraction and sometimes retching. It helps prevent food or objects from entering the airway.

Alternate Names:
Pharyngeal Reflex

Gain

The amount by which a hearing aid or amplifier increases sound intensity, measured in decibels. Correct gain improves hearing while limiting excessive loudness, feedback, discomfort, and further hearing damage.

Gain-Of-Function Mutation

A genetic change that makes a gene or its protein more active, gives it a new activity, or causes activity at the wrong time or place. Its effects range from harmless variation to inherited disease or cancer.

Gaisbock Syndrome

An older term for apparent or relative erythrocytosis in which the hematocrit is high because plasma volume is reduced, while red-cell mass is not increased. The term is used inconsistently and is sometimes called stress polycythemia.

Alternate Names:
Stress Polycythemia; Polycythemia Hypertonica

Gait

A person's pattern of walking, including speed, balance, step length, posture, arm movement, and turning. Gait reflects the combined function of the brain, nerves, muscles, joints, vision, and balance system.

Gait Abnormality

A change from a person's usual walking pattern caused by problems with muscles, joints, nerves, balance, vision, heart function, or general health. Assessment examines speed, stability, symmetry, strength, sensation, and pain.

Gait Apraxia

Difficulty starting or carrying out walking even though basic muscle strength is adequate. It may occur with disease or injury affecting the front of the brain and can cause short steps, freezing, or instability.

Gait Assessment

An examination of how a person walks, including speed, steps, balance, posture, turning, and use of aids. It can reveal problems with strength, sensation, coordination, joints, vision, or thinking.

Gait Ataxia

Unsteady, poorly coordinated walking caused by problems in the cerebellum, sensation pathways, balance organs, or other parts of the nervous system.

Gait Cycle

The sequence of walking movements from initial contact of one foot to its next initial contact. It includes the stance phase, when that foot supports weight, and the swing phase, when it moves forward.

Gait Disturbance

Alternate name; see *Gait Abnormality*.

Gaits

Plural form; see *Gait*.

Gait Speed

Walking speed measured over a set distance. It is a simple indicator of mobility and physical reserve, helps estimate fall or disability risk, and can track changes during illness or rehabilitation.

Gait Training

Therapy that teaches or retrains safer walking after injury, illness, weakness, or balance problems. It may use exercises, parallel bars, walkers, canes, stairs, or other aids to improve independence.

Galactagogue

A medicine or other substance used to increase breast-milk production. Evidence and safety vary by substance, and effects may depend on milk removal, underlying causes, and interactions.

Galactocele

A milk-filled breast cyst caused by blockage of a milk duct, usually during breastfeeding or after weaning. It commonly feels like a painless lump; examination and ultrasound distinguish it from other breast masses.

Galactocerebrosidase Deficiency

An inherited lack of an enzyme needed to break down certain fats in nerve tissue. Severe deficiency causes Krabbe disease, which progressively damages the brain and nerves.

Alternate Names:
Krabbe Disease; Galactosylceramidase Deficiency

Galactocerebrosidase (GALC) Deficiency

Alternate name; see *Galactocerebrosidase Deficiency*.

Galactocerebroside Beta-Galactosidase Deficiency

Alternate name; see *Galactocerebrosidase Deficiency*.

Galactokinase Deficiency

A rare inherited problem in processing galactose, a sugar found in milk. Galactose can build up in the eye and cause cataracts, usually without the liver and other organ damage seen in classic galactosemia.

Alternate Names:
GALK Deficiency; Type II Galactosemia

Galactorrhea

Milk-like breast discharge unrelated to normal pregnancy or breastfeeding. Causes include medicines that raise prolactin, pituitary disorders, hypothyroidism, kidney disease, nipple stimulation, and sometimes no identifiable cause. Spontaneous discharge from one breast, especially if bloody or clear, may have a different cause.

Alternate Names:
Galactorrhoea; Non-Puerperal Lactation

Galactorrhea-Amenorrhea Syndrome

The coexistence of milk-like breast discharge unrelated to pregnancy or breastfeeding and absent menstrual periods. It can occur with high prolactin levels, including from a prolactinoma, but the combination has multiple possible causes; Forbes-Albright syndrome is one specific cause.

Galactorrhoea

Alternate name; see *Galactorrhea*.

Galactosaemia

British spelling; see *Galactosemia*.

Galactose

A simple sugar that forms part of lactose in milk. The body normally processes it for energy, but inherited galactosemia can make milk and other galactose-containing foods dangerous for infants.

Galactose-1-Phosphate Uridyltransferase Blood Test

A blood test measuring an enzyme needed to process galactose. It helps screen for or diagnose classic galactosemia, especially in newborns or infants with symptoms after milk feeding.

Galactose-1-Phosphate Uridyl

Transferase Deficiency

A deficiency of the GALT enzyme that causes classic galactosemia, impairing galactose processing and potentially causing liver injury, jaundice, cataracts, poor feeding, infection, and developmental problems in untreated infants.

Galactose Metabolism

The body's process for changing galactose, part of milk sugar, into energy or other useful substances. Inherited enzyme problems can block this process and cause galactosemia.

Galactosemia

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly process galactose. Classic disease can cause vomiting, jaundice, liver injury, cataracts, serious infection, and developmental problems after milk feeding.

Galactosialidosis

A rare inherited storage disorder in which cells accumulate certain sugar-containing substances. It can cause developmental delay, muscle weakness, bone changes, kidney disease, and eye problems, with severity varying widely.

Galactoside

A compound in which the sugar galactose is joined to another molecule, such as another sugar, a fat, or a protein. Galactosides occur in cells and in some foods.

Galactosyltransferase

An enzyme that attaches galactose to proteins, fats, or other sugars while cells build complex molecules. These molecules support cell structure, recognition, signaling, and nerve insulation.

Galant Reflex

A newborn reflex in which stroking one side of the back causes the infant's trunk to curve toward that side. It normally fades during early infancy; marked asymmetry or persistence can occur with nervous-system problems.

Galeazzi Fracture

A break in the lower part of the radius, one of the forearm bones, with displacement of the nearby joint between the radius and ulna. It can cause wrist pain and difficulty turning the forearm.

Alternate Names:
Piedmont Fracture

Galeazzi Fracture-Dislocation

Alternate name; see *Galeazzi Fracture*.

Galeazzi Sign

A finding in an infant lying with hips and knees bent, in which one knee is lower than the other. It may suggest hip dislocation, developmental hip dysplasia, or unequal thigh-bone length.

Alternate Names:
Allis Sign; Galeazzi Test

Gallavardin Phenomenon

A finding in severe aortic-valve narrowing where the heart murmur sounds harsh near the upper chest but musical near the apex. It reflects different sound frequencies transmitted through the chest.

Gall-Bladder

Alternate spelling; see *Gallbladder*.

Gallbladder

A pear-shaped organ beneath the liver that stores and concentrates bile produced by the liver. When needed for digestion, bile passes through the cystic and common bile ducts into the small intestine.

Alternate Names:
Gall Bladder

Gallbladder Absence

A congenital condition in which the gallbladder did not develop. It may be found incidentally or during evaluation of abdominal symptoms; absence after surgery is described as prior cholecystectomy.

Gallbladder Adenomyomatosis

A usually benign thickening of the gallbladder wall, with small pockets extending into the muscle layer.

It is often found on ultrasound and may cause no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Adenomyoma of Gallbladder; Diverticular Gallbladder Disease

Gallbladder Cancer

Cancer that begins in the gallbladder. It may cause upper-right abdominal pain, jaundice, or weight loss, but can also be found unexpectedly after gallbladder surgery.

Gallbladder Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Gallbladder Cancer*.

Gall Bladder Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Gallbladder Diseases*.

Gallbladder Diseases

Conditions affecting the gallbladder, including stones, inflammation, infection, polyps, abnormal emptying, and cancer. Symptoms and treatment depend on the exact disorder and whether bile flow is blocked.

Gallbladder Duplication

A rare birth variation in which two gallbladders develop, with separate or shared drainage ducts. It may cause no symptoms but can be associated with stones or inflammation and is relevant to surgical planning.

Gallbladder Hydrops

Enlargement of the gallbladder with clear or mucus-like fluid, usually because a blockage prevents bile from draining. It may cause pain and can become infected.

Alternate Names:
Mucocele of Gallbladder; Hydrops Vesicae Felleae

Gallbladder Infection

Informal term sometimes used for acute cholecystitis, which is usually caused by a gallstone blocking the gallbladder outlet. Inflammation does not always mean bacterial infection.

Gallbladder Inflammation

Inflammation of the gallbladder, most often caused by a gallstone blocking its drainage. It can cause persistent right-upper-abdominal pain, fever, nausea, and vomiting.

Alternate Names:
Cholecystitis

Gallbladder Mucocele

Alternate name; see *Gallbladder Hydrops*.

Gallbladder Neck

The narrow end of the gallbladder that joins the cystic duct, the tube carrying bile out of it. A gallstone lodged here can block bile flow.

Alternate Names:
Collum Vesicae Biliaris

Gallbladder Necrosis

Death of gallbladder tissue caused by severe inflammation or inadequate blood supply. It can lead to perforation, abdominal infection, and sepsis.

Gallbladder Pain

Pain from temporary blockage of the gallbladder outlet, usually by a stone. It is often steady, severe, and felt under the right ribs after meals and may include nausea or vomiting.

Alternate Names:
Biliary Colic; Gallstone Pain

Gallbladder Perforation

A hole through the gallbladder wall that allows bile or infected contents into the abdomen. It can cause severe inflammation, abscess, peritonitis, or sepsis.

Gallbladder Polyp

A growth projecting from the inner wall of the gallbladder, often a harmless cholesterol deposit rather than a true tumor. Cancer risk is higher with larger or growing polyps and is also associated with a sessile shape, primary sclerosing cholangitis, and older age.

Gallbladder Radionuclide Scan

A nuclear medicine test that follows a tracer through the liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts. It helps assess suspected gallbladder inflammation, blockage, or abnormal bile flow.

Gallbladder Volvulus

Twisting of the gallbladder around its supporting tissues and duct, cutting off blood flow. It causes sudden severe right-upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, and abdominal irritation.

Gallium

A metallic element used in some radioactive tracers, medical compounds, and technology. Its medical effects depend on the isotope or compound and how it is administered and distributed in the body.

Gallium-68

A radioactive isotope used to label tracers for PET scans. Linked to a suitable targeting molecule, it can help locate some neuroendocrine tumors or prostate-cancer lesions; it is used for diagnosis, not direct treatment.

Gallium Nitrate

A gallium-containing compound formerly used in selected cancer settings to reduce high calcium levels. Its use is limited because it can damage the kidneys and has largely been replaced by other treatments.

Gallium Scan

A nuclear medicine scan using radioactive gallium to locate some infections, inflammation, or tumors. It is used less often now because newer imaging tests may provide more specific or faster information.

Gallop Rhythm

An extra heart sound creating a three- or four-beat rhythm. It may reflect abnormal heart filling, stiff heart muscle, or heart failure and is interpreted with symptoms and other examination findings.

Gallstone

Singular form; see *Gallstones*.

Gallstone Ileus

A blockage of the intestine caused by a large gallstone that has entered through an abnormal connection from the gallbladder. It can cause pain, vomiting, swelling, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Gallstone Pancreatitis

Sudden inflammation of the pancreas caused by a gallstone blocking the shared opening of the bile and pancreatic ducts. It usually causes severe persistent upper-abdominal pain and may be associated with complications or remaining duct stones.

Gallstones

Hard deposits, usually formed in the gallbladder and occasionally in the bile ducts, composed mainly of cholesterol, bilirubin-rich pigment, or a mixture. Cholesterol stones form when bile is supersaturated with cholesterol; pigment stones form when bilirubin compounds precipitate. Black pigment stones are associated with chronic hemolysis, while brown stones are associated with biliary infection or stasis. Many cause no symptoms, but duct blockage may cause biliary colic or complications such as inflammation, jaundice, infection, or pancreatitis.

Alternate Names:
Cholelithiasis; Biliary Calculi

GALT Deficiency

Abbreviation; see *Galactose-1-Phosphate Uridyl Transferase Deficiency*.

Galvanocautery

Use of heat generated by electric current to destroy selected tissue or control bleeding during a procedure. It can cause burns or damage nearby structures if not carefully controlled.

Gambling Disorder

A persistent inability to control gambling despite financial, relationship, work, health, or emotional harm. The disorder can cause debt, secrecy, distress, and suicide risk and benefits from professional behavioral and mental-health support.

Alternate Names:

Pathological Gambling; Compulsive Gambling; Ludomania

Gamete

A mature reproductive cell, such as a sperm or egg, containing one set of chromosomes. Two gametes combine during fertilization to form a cell with genetic material from both biological parents.

Gamete Intrafallopian Transfer

An assisted-reproduction procedure in which eggs and sperm are placed into a fallopian tube so fertilization may occur inside the body. It is now used less often than in-vitro fertilization.

Gametogenesis

The formation and maturation of sperm or eggs in the testes or ovaries. It includes cell division that reduces chromosome number so gametes can combine during fertilization.

Gamma-Aminobutyric Acid

A chemical messenger that usually reduces nerve activity in the brain and spinal cord. It helps regulate sleep, anxiety, muscle activity, and seizures through two main receptor types.

Alternate Names:
GABA

Gamma-Benzene Hexachloride

An insecticide, also called lindane, that can cause nervous-system toxicity and seizures after excessive exposure. Medical use is restricted in many places because safer treatments are available.

Gamma Camera

A device used in some nuclear-medicine scans to detect radiation from a small tracer inside the body and create pictures showing an organ's structure or activity.

Gamma-Chemokines

Signaling proteins that attract or activate immune cells through specific receptors. They help coordinate inflammation, immune surveillance, and movement of defensive cells into affected tissue.

Gamma Globulin

The part of blood plasma containing most immunoglobulins, or antibodies, which help defend against infections and can be measured or given as immune treatment.

Gamma-Globulin

Alternate spelling; see *Gamma Globulin*.

Gamma-Glutamyl Transferase Blood Test

A blood test measuring an enzyme found mainly in the liver and bile ducts. It can support evaluation of liver or bile-duct disease and help explain a high alkaline-phosphatase result.

Gamma-Glutamyl Transferase Test

A blood test measuring GGT enzyme activity to assess biliary tract disease, biliary obstruction, and liver damage; see *Gamma-Glutamyl Transferase Blood Test*.

Gammaherpesvirinae

A subgroup of herpesviruses that establish long-lasting infection in lymphoid or related cells. Some members, including Epstein-Barr virus, can cause human disease and contribute to certain cancers.

Gamma Hydroxybutyrate

A central-nervous-system depressant that can cause drowsiness, confusion, slowed breathing, coma, or death in overdose. It is also misused recreationally and can cause dependence and withdrawal.

Gamma-Hydroxybutyrate Toxicity

Rapid-onset central nervous system depression from GHB or related compounds, with drowsiness, ataxia, vomiting, bradycardia, respiratory depression, coma, and sometimes agitation or delirium during recovery. There is no specific antidote; protect the airway, support ventilation, and monitor until mental status and breathing recover.

Gamma-Interferon

A cytokine made by activated immune cells that strengthens macrophage activity and cell-mediated defense against certain infections. It also contributes to inflammation and immune regulation.

Gamma Knife

A noninvasive radiation treatment that aims many focused beams at selected brain tumors or other lesions. It avoids an open operation but can cause swelling, bleeding, or injury to nearby brain tissue.

Gamma Knife Radiosurgery

Alternate name; see *Gamma Knife*.

Gamma Rays

High-energy electromagnetic radiation produced by radioactive decay or nuclear reactions. It can damage cells and is used in controlled amounts for some cancer treatments and medical sterilization.

Gamma-Ray Therapy

Treatment that uses controlled gamma radiation to damage the DNA of selected abnormal cells. It can treat some cancers, but nearby healthy tissue may also be affected and side effects depend on the treated area.

Gamna-Gandy Bodies

Small fibrous nodules in the spleen containing iron and calcium deposits. They form after repeated small hemorrhages, often in chronic congestion of the spleen or sickle cell disease, and may be visible on imaging.

Alternate Names:
Gamna-Gandy Nodules; Siderofibrotic Bodies

GAN

Abbreviation; see *Giant Axonal Neuropathy*.

Ganciclovir

An antiviral medicine that interferes with viral DNA production and is used mainly for serious cytomegalovirus infection. It can suppress bone marrow, affect the kidneys, and cause other serious toxicity.

Ganglia

Groups of nerve-cell bodies outside the brain and spinal cord. They relay and organize signals between the central nervous system and the rest of the body.

Ganglioglioma

A usually slow-growing tumor containing nerve cells and supporting brain cells. It often causes seizures and may occur in the brain or spinal cord; treatment commonly involves surgical removal.

Ganglion

A cluster of nerve-cell bodies outside the brain and spinal cord. It acts as a relay point for signals between the central nervous system and body tissues.

Ganglion Cell

A nerve cell located in a ganglion. Retinal ganglion cells collect visual signals and send them through the optic nerve to the brain.

Ganglion Cyst

A noncancerous, fluid-filled lump near a joint or tendon, most often at the wrist or hand. It may be painless or cause pressure, pain, numbness, or limited movement.

Ganglionectomy

Surgical removal of a ganglion, a cluster of nerve-cell bodies, or occasionally a ganglion cyst. The purpose, benefits, and risks depend on the exact structure and body site being treated.

Ganglioneuroblastoma

A tumor made of both mature and immature nerve-related cells, usually in the adrenal or tissue beside the spine. It mainly affects children and may cause a mass, pain, high blood pressure, or other symptoms.

Ganglioneuroma

A usually noncancerous tumor arising from nerve tissue of the autonomic nervous system. It often causes no symptoms but may produce a mass, pain,

or hormone-related effects depending on its location.

Ganglioneuromatosis

Diffuse overgrowth of ganglion cells, nerve fibers, and supporting tissue, most often in the intestinal wall. Intestinal disease can disrupt bowel movement and cause abdominal swelling, constipation, diarrhea, or obstruction; it is associated with multiple endocrine neoplasia type 2B.

Ganglionic Blockers

Medicines that interrupt nerve signals at autonomic ganglia, affecting blood pressure, heart rate, digestion, and other automatic functions. They are rarely used because of widespread side effects.

Ganglions

Alternate plural form; see *Ganglion*.

Ganglioside

A fat-containing molecule in cell membranes, especially nerve cells. Gangliosides help cells communicate and recognize one another; abnormal accumulation occurs in several inherited storage disorders.

Gangliosidosis

A group of inherited disorders in which gangliosides accumulate inside cells because a breakdown enzyme is missing. The buildup often damages the nervous system and may also affect the eyes, bones, organs, and development.

Gangliosidosis GM2 Type 2

Alternate name; see *Sandhoff Disease*.

Gangrene

Death of body tissue caused by severely reduced blood flow, infection, injury, or a combination of these factors. It may affect skin, muscle, or an internal organ. The area may become discolored, cold, swollen, painful, numb, or foul-smelling; fever, confusion, or feeling very ill may occur with spreading infection.

Ganser Syndrome

A rare dissociative or psychiatric syndrome characterized by approximate answers, confusion, altered awareness, and sometimes hallucinations or neurologic-like symptoms. It may occur with severe stress, trauma, other mental disorders, or medical and substance-related conditions.

Gap Junction

A tiny connection between neighboring cells that allows ions and small molecules to pass directly between them. Gap junctions help coordinate heartbeats, nerve activity, and tissue growth.

Gardnerella

A group of bacteria that may live in the genital tract. Overgrowth of Gardnerella, especially G. vaginalis, can contribute to bacterial vaginosis with discharge, odor, and altered vaginal bacteria.

Gardnerella Vaginalis

A bacterium associated with bacterial vaginosis, in which normal vaginal bacteria become imbalanced. It may be present without illness; when symptomatic, discharge, odor, irritation, or burning can occur.

Gardner Syndrome

An inherited condition caused by an APC gene change, producing many colon polyps and increasing colorectal-cancer risk. It may also cause bone growths, dental abnormalities, skin cysts, and desmoid tumors.

Alternate Names:
Bone Tumor-Epidermoid Cyst-Polyposis; Familial Adenomatous Polyposis With Osteomas

Gargle

To rinse the mouth and throat with liquid while making a bubbling sound. Gargling may soothe irritation or help deliver a prescribed treatment.

Garré's Osteomyelitis

A chronic inflammatory reaction in the jawbone, often near an infected tooth, causing firm swelling.

Dental infection, persistent swelling, or pain may be present.

Gartner Duct

A remnant of an embryonic duct in the female reproductive tract. It can persist harmlessly or form a cyst along the side wall of the vagina or broad ligament.

Gartner Duct Cyst

A usually harmless fluid-filled cyst arising from an embryonic duct remnant along the side wall of the vagina. It often causes no symptoms, but a large cyst may cause pressure, pain, or difficulty with intercourse.

Gas

A state of matter without a fixed shape or volume. In medicine, gas may mean air or another gas in the digestive tract, blood, tissues, or a body cavity.

Gas And Gas Pains

Fullness, bloating, cramps, or discomfort from swallowed air or gas made by intestinal bacteria. Foods, constipation, food intolerance, and digestive disorders can contribute.

Gas Chromatography

A laboratory method that separates vaporized chemicals so they can be identified or measured. It is often combined with mass spectrometry to test medicines, poisons, pollutants, or biological samples.

Gas Exchange

Movement of oxygen from inhaled air into blood and carbon dioxide from blood into exhaled air. Oxygen then moves to tissues while carbon dioxide returns to the lungs for removal.

Gas – Flatulence

Passage of gas from the digestive tract through the anus, caused by swallowed air and bacterial digestion of food. It is normal, but excess gas with bloating or pain may reflect diet, constipation, or digestive disease.

Gas (Flatus)

Alternate name; see *Gas – Flatulence*.

Alternate Names:
Flatulence; Flatus Expulsion

Gas Gangrene

A rapidly progressive infection in which toxin-producing bacteria destroy muscle and produce gas in tissue. It is usually caused by *Clostridium* species and can cause severe pain, swelling, skin discoloration, systemic toxicity, and shock. See also *Clostridial Myonecrosis*.

Gaskin Maneuver

A maneuver for shoulder dystocia in which the birthing person moves onto hands and knees. The position can change pelvic dimensions and help release the baby's shoulder.

Alternate Names:
All-Fours Position; Hands-and-Knees Posture

Gasoline Poisoning

Harm from swallowing, inhaling, or getting gasoline on the skin. It can cause nausea, dizziness, drowsiness, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, or chemical lung injury, especially if vomited and inhaled.

Gas Poisoning

Illness caused by inhaling a toxic gas. Carbon monoxide and cyanide interfere with oxygen delivery or use, while chlorine, ammonia, and similar irritants injure the airways and lungs. Effects may include headache, confusion, cough, breathing difficulty, pulmonary edema, seizures, or collapse.

Gas Scavenger

A substance or device that removes unwanted gases from a fluid, container, or breathing system. In healthcare it may help prevent toxic exposure or maintain safe gas delivery.

Gasserian Ganglion

A cluster of nerve cells near the base of the skull

that carries sensation from the face and controls some chewing muscles. It is involved in trigeminal neuralgia and other facial-nerve disorders.

Gastralgia

Pain in the upper abdomen or stomach area. Causes include indigestion, reflux, ulcers, gallbladder disease, pancreatic inflammation, infection, or other conditions; severe pain may occur with bleeding, vomiting, fever, or weight loss.

Gas Transport

Movement of oxygen from the lungs to body tissues and carbon dioxide back to the lungs through the blood. Hemoglobin carries most oxygen and part of the carbon dioxide.

Gastrectomy

Surgery removing part or all of the stomach, usually for cancer or severe disease. Food passage is reconstructed, and possible effects include early fullness, weight loss, nutritional deficiencies, reflux, or dumping symptoms.

Gastric Acid

Strong acid made by the stomach lining that helps break down food, activate digestive enzymes, and kill many swallowed microbes. Excess can contribute to reflux or ulcers; too little can impair digestion and nutrient absorption.

Gastric Adenocarcinoma

The most common stomach cancer, arising from cells lining the stomach. It may cause indigestion, pain, early fullness, vomiting, bleeding, or weight loss; tissue examination and staging identify its type and extent.

Gastric Adenoma

A usually noncancerous growth of gland-forming cells in the stomach lining. Some adenomas can develop into stomach cancer, so their size, appearance, and tissue findings matter.

Gastric Analysis

Examination of stomach contents for volume, acidity, or selected substances. It is used only in specific situations because endoscopy, imaging, and blood tests are more useful for many stomach disorders.

Gastric Antral Vascular Ectasia

Enlarged fragile blood vessels in the lower stomach that can cause slow internal bleeding and iron-deficiency anemia. It may appear as red stripes or spots during endoscopy and is associated with some liver and autoimmune diseases.

Alternate Names:
GAVE; Watermelon Stomach

Gastric Antrum

The lower part of the stomach between its body and the pylorus. It grinds food and helps regulate stomach emptying; its G cells release gastrin, which stimulates acid secretion elsewhere in the stomach.

Gastric Balloon

A temporary balloon placed inside the stomach to create fullness and support weight loss. Nausea, vomiting, reflux, deflation, blockage, bleeding, or perforation can occur.

Gastric Bezoar

A mass of material that cannot be digested and collects in the stomach. It may contain plant fiber, hair, or medicines and can cause fullness, pain, vomiting, blockage, or poor nutrition.

Gastric Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of stomach lining, usually during endoscopy, for laboratory examination. It can help assess inflammation, infection, precancerous changes, or cancer.

Gastric Body

The main middle part of the stomach between the fundus and the antrum. It stores and mixes food and contains glands that release acid and digestive substances.

Gastric Bypass

An operation that makes a small stomach pouch and connects it to the small intestine, changing food intake, gut-hormone signals, and nutrient absorption. Roux-en-Y gastric bypass is a common form; the term does not refer to every bariatric operation.

Gastric Bypass Surgery

Alternate name; see *Gastric Bypass*.

Gastric Cancer

See *Stomach Cancer*.

Gastric Carcinoid Tumor

Older term for a usually well-differentiated neuroendocrine tumor in the stomach; see *Gastric Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Gastric Cardia

The anatomical transition zone of the stomach immediately surrounding the gastroesophageal junction where the tubular esophagus empties into the stomach, lined by simple columnar mucous-secreting glands without parietal or chief cells.

Gastric Culture

A laboratory test that grows bacteria from a stomach sample, usually collected during endoscopy. It can identify Helicobacter pylori and help select antibiotics, although other tests are more commonly used.

Alternate Names:
Helicobacter Pylori Culture; Gastric Biopsy Culture

Gastric Crohn's Disease

See *Gastroduodenal Crohn Disease*.

Gastric Diverticulum

A pouch that bulges outward from the stomach wall. It is often present from birth and causes no symptoms, but some people have pain, nausea, or trouble swallowing, depending on its size and location.

Gastric Dysplasia

Abnormal cells in the stomach lining that have some features of cancer but have not invaded deeper tissue. Low- or high-grade changes may increase the risk of stomach cancer.

Gastric Emptying

The passage of food and liquid from the stomach into the small intestine through coordinated stomach contractions and opening of the pylorus. Abnormally slow or rapid emptying can cause digestive symptoms.

Gastric Emptying Study

A test that measures how quickly food leaves the stomach. The patient eats a meal containing a small tracer, and a scanner records the remaining food over several hours to detect unusually slow or rapid emptying.

Gastric Fistula

An abnormal passage between the stomach and another organ or the skin. Stomach contents may leak through it, causing drainage, infection, skin irritation, dehydration, or poor nutrition.

Gastric Fundus

The upper, rounded part of the stomach, located above the main stomach body and near the diaphragm. It can expand to store food and contains glands that produce digestive secretions.

Gastric Glands

Glands in the stomach lining that make acid, digestive enzymes, mucus, intrinsic factor, and hormones.

Gastric Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the stomach, commonly caused by an ulcer, a tumor, or blood-vessel damage. It may cause vomiting blood, black stools, dizziness, anemia, or shock. It is one possible source of upper gastrointestinal bleeding, which can also come from the esophagus or duodenum.

Alternate Names:
Gastric Bleeding

Gastric Intestinal Metaplasia

A change in which cells lining the stomach become more like cells that normally line the intestine, often after long-term inflammation. It can raise the future risk of stomach cancer, especially when widespread or severe.

Gastric Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to the stomach that deprives its lining or wall of oxygen. It is uncommon because the stomach has a rich blood supply, but severe or prolonged ischemia can cause ulcers, bleeding, tissue death, or a hole in the wall.

Gastric Juice

Fluid made by the stomach containing acid, digestive enzymes, mucus, water, salts, and intrinsic factor. It helps break down food, protect the stomach lining, and absorb vitamin B12 later in digestion.

Gastric Lavage

A procedure that flushes the stomach through a tube passed through the mouth or nose. It is rarely used because it can cause aspiration or injury and is reserved for selected emergencies.

Gastric Leiomyoma

A usually noncancerous growth of smooth muscle in the stomach wall. It may cause no symptoms or appear as a lump beneath the stomach lining; larger growths can bleed or block food passage.

Gastric Leiomyosarcoma

A rare cancer of smooth muscle in the stomach wall. It may cause pain, bleeding, vomiting, or a mass and is evaluated with imaging and biopsy; treatment usually involves surgery when possible.

Gastric Lipoma

A usually noncancerous growth made of fat cells in the stomach wall. Most cause no symptoms, but a larger one may bleed, cause pain, or block the stomach outlet.

Gastric Lymphoma

A lymphoma that starts in the stomach. Some mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue (MALT) lymphomas are linked to *Helicobacter pylori*; the relationship and clinical course vary by lymphoma type.

Gastric MALT Lymphoma

A type of lymphoma that starts in immune tissue in the stomach lining. It is often linked to *Helicobacter pylori* infection and is usually slow-growing; see also *MALT Lymphoma*.

Gastric Malignancy

See *Stomach Cancer*.

Gastric Motility

The coordinated muscle activity that mixes stomach contents and moves them toward the small intestine.

Gastric Dysmotility

Abnormal movement of food through the stomach because its muscle contractions are weak or poorly timed. It may cause nausea, fullness, bloating, or delayed stomach emptying; gastroparesis is one specific form.

Gastric Mucosa

The moist inner lining of the stomach. It contains glands that produce acid, digestive enzymes, mucus, and intrinsic factor and is protected by a mucus barrier; inflammation or injury can cause pain or bleeding.

Gastric Muscularis

The muscle layers in the stomach wall that mix food and move it toward the pylorus. The stomach has an extra inner muscle layer that helps with grinding.

Gastric Necrosis

Death of stomach tissue caused by severely reduced blood flow, corrosive injury, extreme stretching, infection, or another serious insult. It can lead to perforation, severe infection, and shock.

Gastric Neuroendocrine Tumor

A tumor arising from hormone-producing cells in the stomach lining. Some grow slowly and are linked to long-term stomach inflammation or excess gastrin, while others behave more aggressively; behavior depends on the tumor type and grade.

Gastric Neuroendocrine Tumour

Alternate spelling; see *Gastric Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Gastric Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage that prevents food and liquid from leaving the stomach normally. It may cause repeated vomiting, upper-abdominal pain, fullness, swelling, dehydration, and weight loss.

Gastric Outlet Obstruction

Blockage where the stomach empties into the small intestine, usually at the pylorus or duodenum. Causes include ulcer scarring, tumors, inflammation, and infantile pyloric stenosis; vomiting can cause dehydration.

Gastric Perforation

A hole through the stomach wall that allows stomach contents to leak into the abdomen. It can cause severe inflammation, infection, and shock.

Gastric Pneumatosis

Gas within the stomach wall. It may result from pressure-related injury and be relatively mild, or from severe infection, which can destroy tissue and cause sepsis.

Gastric Polyps

Growths projecting from the stomach lining. Most are harmless, but some types are linked to chronic inflammation, inherited conditions, or long-term acid-suppressing treatment and may contain precancerous changes.

Gastric Rugae

Folds in the inner lining of the empty stomach that flatten as the stomach fills. They allow the stomach to expand and increase the lining's surface area.

Gastric Secretion

The release of acid, enzymes, mucus, intrinsic factor, and hormones by the stomach lining.

Gastric Schwannoma

A usually noncancerous growth from nerve-supporting cells in the stomach wall. It may cause no symptoms or appear as a lump beneath the stomach lining; its type is confirmed by examining tissue.

Gastric Serosa

The thin outer covering of the stomach, formed by the visceral peritoneum. It reduces friction as the stomach moves inside the abdomen.

Gastric Stenosis

Abnormal narrowing of the stomach or its outlet that slows or blocks emptying. It may result from birth defects, ulcer scarring, inflammation, tumors, or thickening of the outlet muscle.

Gastric Submucosa

The connective-tissue layer beneath the stomach lining. It contains blood vessels, lymph vessels, nerves, and supporting tissue.

Gastric Suction

Removal of stomach contents through a tube passed through the nose or mouth. It may relieve severe distension or vomiting from obstruction and is used only when clinically indicated because complications can occur.

Alternate Names:
Nasogastric Aspiration; Stomach Pumping

Gastric Surgery

An operation on the stomach to remove disease, repair damage, reduce its size, or bypass a blockage. The exact procedure and risks depend on the condition and may include bleeding, infection, leakage, or altered digestion.

Gastric Tissue Biopsy And Culture

Removal of small stomach-lining samples during endoscopy for microscopic examination and, when needed, laboratory testing for infection. It can investigate inflammation, Helicobacter pylori, precancerous changes, or tumors.

Gastric Tuberculosis

A rare form of tuberculosis that affects the stomach. It may cause pain, ulcers, bleeding, or a blockage and can resemble an ulcer or stomach cancer; diagnosis may require testing a stomach-tissue sample for tuberculosis.

Alternate Names:
Endoscopic Gastric Biopsy; Mucosal Culture

Gastric Ulcer

An open sore in the stomach lining, commonly caused by Helicobacter pylori infection or anti-inflammatory medicines. It may cause burning upper-abdominal pain, bleeding, anemia, or perforation.

Gastric Varices

Enlarged, fragile veins in the stomach caused by increased pressure in the portal circulation, often from advanced liver disease. Rupture can cause sudden, life-threatening vomiting of blood.

Gastric Volvulus

Twisting of the stomach that can block food passage and cut off blood supply. It may cause sudden severe upper-abdominal pain, retching without vomiting, bloating, and inability to pass a tube.

Gastric Wall

The layered wall of the stomach, made up of the mucosa, submucosa, muscle layers, and outer covering. It allows the stomach to store, mix, and move food.

Gastric Xanthoma

A small, usually harmless yellow patch in the stomach lining made of immune cells containing fat. It is often found during endoscopy and may occur where the lining has been inflamed or injured.

Gastrin

A hormone made mainly in the lower stomach and upper small intestine. It stimulates stomach acid production and helps maintain the stomach lining; levels rise after eating and may become excessive in certain diseases.

Gastrin Blood Test

A blood test measuring the hormone gastrin. It helps investigate excessive stomach acid, recurrent ulcers, or loss of acid-producing cells. Acid-suppressing medicines and fasting can significantly affect the result.

Alternate Names:
Serum Gastrin Level; Fasting Gastrin Assay

Gastrinoma

A tumor that makes too much gastrin, a hormone that causes the stomach to produce acid. It usually starts in the pancreas or duodenum and may cause Zollinger–Ellison syndrome, repeated peptic ulcers, diarrhea, and acid reflux. Some cases are linked to MEN1 and may spread to the liver or nearby lymph nodes.

Gastrin-Releasing Peptide

A signaling molecule released by nerves in the digestive tract that stimulates G cells in the stomach to release gastrin. Gastrin then promotes stomach acid secretion and other digestive functions.

Alternate Names:
GRP; Mammalian Bombesin

Gastrin Secretion

Release of the hormone gastrin, mainly from cells in the lower stomach after food enters. Gastrin increases stomach acid and digestive-enzyme release and supports growth and function of the stomach lining.

Gastritis

Inflammation of the stomach lining. It may begin suddenly (acute) or last a long time (chronic),

and may cause no symptoms or upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, or bleeding. *H. pylori* infection and autoimmune disease are important causes. Some medicines, alcohol, and severe illness can also injure the lining; when injury occurs without prominent inflammation, it is called gastropathy.

Gastrocnemius

The large muscle at the back of the calf. It helps point the foot downward and bend the knee during standing, walking, running, and jumping; injury can cause calf pain, swelling, or weakness.

Gastrocnemius Muscle

Alternate name; see *Gastrocnemius*.

Gastroduodenal Artery

A major arterial branch arising from the common hepatic artery, descending posterior to the first part of the duodenum before dividing into the right gastro-omental and superior pancreaticoduodenal arteries; erosion by a posterior duodenal ulcer produces massive upper gastrointestinal hemorrhage.

Alternate Names:
GDA

Gastroduodenal Crohn Disease

Crohn disease affecting the stomach or first part of the small intestine. It may cause upper-abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, weight loss, ulcers, narrowing, or blockage; treatment varies with symptoms and disease severity.

Gastroduodenostomy

An operation creating a new opening between the stomach and duodenum so food can pass directly into the small intestine. It may bypass a blockage or restore passage after part of the stomach is removed.

Gastroenteritis

Infection or inflammation of the stomach and intestines, commonly caused by viruses and sometimes by bacteria, parasites, or toxins. It usually causes diarrhea, vomiting, cramps, and fever and can lead to dehydration.

Gastroenteritis Bacterial

Inflammation of the stomach or intestines caused by bacteria, usually after contaminated food or water. It can cause diarrhea, cramps, fever, vomiting, and dehydration; blood in stool or severe illness may occur.

Gastroenteritis Viral

Alternate index label; see *Viral Gastroenteritis*.

Gastroenterologic Surgery

Alternate name; see *Gastrointestinal Surgery*.

Gastroenterologist

A physician specializing in disorders of the digestive tract, liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, and pancreas. They diagnose and treat digestive problems using medicines, endoscopy, procedures, lifestyle care, and surgery referrals.

Gastroenterology

The medical specialty concerned with the digestive tract, liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, and pancreas. Gastroenterologists diagnose and treat these conditions with medicines, endoscopy, procedures, and referrals for surgery.

Gastroenterostomy

Surgical creation of an opening between the stomach and a segment of the small intestine, usually the jejunum, to bypass or replace a blocked or diseased gastric outlet.

Gastroepiploic Artery

The gastroepiploic arteries run along the greater curve of the stomach and supply blood to the stomach and nearby omentum.

Gastroesophageal

Relating to both the stomach and esophagus, especially their joining point or the backward movement of stomach contents into the esophagus.

Gastroesophageal Junction

Adenocarcinoma

A gland-forming cancer arising where the esophagus joins the stomach. It may cause difficulty swallowing, reflux, weight loss, anemia, or bleeding; endoscopy, biopsy, and scans determine treatment and extent.

Gastroesophageal Reflux

Backward flow of stomach contents into the esophagus. It may cause heartburn, sour fluid in the throat, cough, chest discomfort, or no symptoms. Spitting up is common in healthy infants and usually resolves with age; reflux is called disease when it causes troublesome symptoms or complications.

Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease

A chronic digestive condition that occurs when stomach acid and digestive juices repeatedly flow backward into the esophagus (the swallowing tube). This backwash irritates and inflames the delicate lining of the esophagus. Common symptoms include a burning sensation in the chest (heartburn), acid regurgitation or a sour taste in the mouth, chest discomfort, difficulty swallowing, or a persistent dry cough.

Alternate Names:
GERD; Acid Reflux Disease; Reflux Esophagitis

Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)

Alternate name; see *Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease*.

Alternate Names:
GERD; Acid Reflux Disease

Gastroesophageal Z-Line

The visible boundary between the squamous lining of the esophagus and the columnar lining of the stomach. Its position relative to the gastroesophageal junction is assessed during endoscopy, including when evaluating Barrett esophagus.

Alternate Names:
Squamocolumnar Junction; SCJ; Ora Serrata of the Esophagus

Gastrogastric Intussusception

A rare condition in which one part of the stomach folds into an adjoining part, sometimes because of a polyp or tumor. It may cause pain, vomiting, blockage, or bleeding.

Gastrografin Study

An X-ray study using a water-soluble contrast liquid to show the digestive tract. It may be chosen when a leak or perforation is possible, because the contrast is safer outside the tract than barium.

Gastrointestinal

Relating to the stomach and intestines, or to the complete digestive tract from the mouth to the anus. These organs digest food, absorb nutrients and water, move contents forward, and remove waste.

Gastrointestinal Agents

Medicines or other substances that act on the digestive tract to relieve or treat problems such as nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation, ulcers, reflux, or intestinal spasms. Their effects and risks depend on the specific agent.

Gastrointestinal Amyloidosis

Buildup of abnormal protein deposits in the digestive tract. It can impair movement, absorption, or bleeding control and may occur with disease affecting other organs such as the heart, kidneys, or nerves.

Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Bleeding anywhere in the digestive tract. It may be acute or chronic and may come from the upper digestive tract, small intestine, or lower digestive tract. It can cause vomiting blood, black stools, or red blood in the stool.

Gastrointestinal Bleeding Scan

A nuclear-medicine scan that uses a small radioactive tracer in the blood to find active bleeding in the digestive tract. It can help localize bleeding when endoscopy does not identify the source.

Gastrointestinal Cancer

Cancer arising in the digestive tract or related organs, including the esophagus, stomach, intestine, rectum, liver, pancreas, and biliary tract. Symptoms and treatment depend on the organ, tumor type, and stage.

Gastrointestinal Decontamination

Methods used after some poisonings to reduce absorption, such as activated charcoal or whole-bowel irrigation. The choice depends on the substance, timing, symptoms, and risk of aspiration; stomach washing is rarely used.

Gastrointestinal Disease

Any disorder affecting the digestive tract or related organs. Examples include reflux, ulcers, inflammatory bowel disease, infection, malabsorption, liver disease, and cancer.

Gastrointestinal Disease and Pregnancy

Pregnancy can alter gastrointestinal motility and symptoms, while inflammatory bowel disease, reflux, gallbladder or liver disease, and bowel obstruction can affect nutrition and pregnancy. Severe pain, persistent vomiting, bleeding, fever, or dehydration can signal a complication.

Gastrointestinal Disorder

A broad category for diseases affecting the digestive tract, from the esophagus to the anus; it is not one specific diagnosis. The disorder may involve a particular organ or function, such as reflux from the esophagus, inflammation of the bowel, or impaired nutrient absorption.

Gastrointestinal Fistula

An abnormal connection between the digestive tract and another organ, the skin, or another section of bowel. Digestive fluid may leak through it, causing infection, dehydration, skin damage, or poor nutrition.

Gastrointestinal Failure

See *Intestinal Failure*.

Gastrointestinal Foreign Bodies

Objects swallowed or inserted into the gastrointestinal tract that may pass spontaneously or become lodged, cause obstruction, perforation, bleeding, or poisoning. Evaluation and removal depend on the object, location, symptoms, and risk of injury.

Gastrointestinal Gas

Air or other gas within the stomach or intestines, usually from swallowed air or bacterial digestion of food. Excess gas may cause belching, bloating, cramps, or passing gas and can increase with constipation or food intolerance.

Gastrointestinal Health

Normal digestive-system function without active digestive disease or symptoms that impair quality of life. It includes breaking down food, absorbing nutrients and water, and moving waste through the bowel.

Gastrointestinal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from any part of the digestive tract, from the esophagus to the anus. It may cause vomiting blood, black stools, red blood in stool, anemia, dizziness, or shock.

Gastrointestinal Hormone

A chemical messenger made by cells in the digestive tract that helps regulate stomach acid, intestinal movement, digestion, appetite, gallbladder activity, or blood-glucose control.

Gastrointestinal Motility Disorder

Abnormal movement of food, liquid, or stool through the digestive tract. It can cause difficulty swallowing, nausea, vomiting, bloating, abdominal pain, constipation, or diarrhea; causes may involve digestive muscles, nerves, hormones, or a blockage.

Gastrointestinal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth arising in the digestive tract. It may be a harmless growth, a precancerous change, or cancer; symptoms and treatment depend on its tissue, location, and behavior.

Gastrointestinal Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of food, fluid, or stool through the digestive tract. It can cause cramping pain, vomiting, swelling, constipation, dehydration, loss of blood supply, perforation, or sepsis.

Gastrointestinal Pain

Pain arising from the digestive tract or related organs. Causes include infection, ulcers, inflammation, blockage, gallstones, and diseases of the liver or pancreas. It may be severe, persistent, or worsening.

Gastrointestinal Perforation

A hole through the wall of the digestive tract that allows its contents to leak into surrounding tissue. It can cause severe abdominal pain, peritonitis, sepsis, and shock.

Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor

A mesenchymal tumor arising from specialized cells in the digestive-tract wall, most often the stomach or small intestine. Many are driven by changes in *KIT* or *PDGFRA*. They may cause bleeding, pain, or blockage, or be found incidentally; risk depends on tumor size, site, cell division rate, and rupture.

Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumors

Alternate plural form; see *Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor*.

Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumors (GISTs)

Alternate plural form; see *Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor*.

Gastrointestinal Surgery

Surgery to treat diseases or injuries of the digestive tract and related organs, including the esophagus, stomach, intestines, liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, and pancreas. Surgeons may specialize in particular organs or procedures.

Gastrointestinal System

The connected organs that move and digest food, absorb nutrients and water, and remove solid waste. It includes the mouth, esophagus, stomach, intestines, rectum, and anus, with help from the liver, gallbladder, and pancreas.

Gastrointestinal Tract

The continuous digestive passage from the mouth through the esophagus, stomach, small and large intestines, rectum, and anus. It moves food, digests it, absorbs nutrients and water, and removes waste.

Gastrointestinal Villi

Tiny finger-like projections lining the small intestine that greatly increase the area available to absorb nutrients and water. Each contains small blood vessels and a lymph vessel that carry absorbed substances away.

Gastrojejunostomy

An operation creating a new connection between the stomach and jejunum, the middle part of the small intestine. It may bypass a blocked stomach outlet or replace a damaged section of digestive tract.

Gastrojejunostomy Tube Intolerance

A descriptive term for gastrointestinal symptoms associated with feeding through a gastrojejunostomy (GJ) tube. Symptoms may include nausea, vomiting, retching, abdominal pain or distension, and diarrhea. It is not a single diagnosis; possible contributors include feed composition or delivery rate, tube displacement or blockage, altered gut motility, or other disease.

Gastromalacia

Abnormal softening of the stomach wall. It is a rare descriptive finding that may result from severe inflammation, poor blood supply, or tissue injury and can increase the risk of weakness or perforation.

Gastroparesis

A condition in which the stomach empties food too slowly even though there is no blockage. It may cause early or lasting fullness after meals, nausea, vomiting, bloating, or upper-abdominal discomfort. Causes include diabetes, surgery, some medicines, and nerve disorders; some cases have no known cause.

Alternate Names:
Delayed Gastric Emptying

Gastropathy

Damage or disease of the stomach lining without the prominent inflammation seen in gastritis. Causes include medicines, alcohol, poor blood flow, bile reflux, and severe illness; symptoms may include pain, nausea, or bleeding.

Gastroplasty

Surgery that changes the size or shape of the stomach, usually to support weight loss or repair a defect. Possible complications include bleeding, infection, leakage, reflux, and nutritional deficiencies.

Gastroptosis

Downward displacement of the stomach from its usual position. It may be seen on imaging and may or may not cause symptoms; the finding alone does not establish the cause of digestive complaints.

Alternate Names:
Gastric Prolapse

Gastroschisis

A birth defect in which the intestine, and sometimes other organs, protrudes through an opening beside the umbilicus without a protective covering. The exposed bowel may be swollen or damaged.

Gastroschisis Repair

Surgical repair of gastroschisis, a congenital abdominal wall defect where intestines protrude through an opening near the umbilicus. The bowel is returned to the abdomen and the defect is closed, sometimes in stages using a temporary covering.

Gastroscope

A thin, flexible instrument with a light and camera used to view the esophagus, stomach, and first part of the small intestine. It can also pass tools for biopsy or treatment.

Gastroscopy

Examination of the esophagus, stomach, and duodenum using a flexible camera tube passed through the mouth. It can identify bleeding, ulcers, inflammation, narrowing, or tumors and allows biopsies or selected treatments.

Gastrospenic Fistulization

Misspelling; see *Gastrosplenic Fistula*.

Gastrosplenic Fistula

An abnormal connection between the stomach and spleen. It may result from lymphoma, another tumor, ulceration, or infection and can cause abdominal pain or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Gastrostomy

A surgically created opening through the abdominal wall into the stomach. A tube placed through it can provide food, fluids, or medicines or remove stomach contents when normal feeding is unsafe or impossible.

Gastrostomy Tube

A tube passed through the abdominal wall into the stomach to provide food, fluids, or medicines when swallowing is unsafe or inadequate. Problems can include skin infection, leakage, blockage, bleeding, and movement of the tube.

Gastrostomy Tube Insertion

A surgical, laparoscopic, or endoscopic procedure in which a feeding tube is placed directly through the abdominal wall into the stomach for long-term enteral nutrition.

Alternate Names:
G-Tube Placement

Gastrostomy Tube Placement

The surgical or endoscopic creation of an opening into the stomach to place a feeding tube directly through the abdominal wall; see *Gastrostomy Tube Insertion* and *Percutaneous Endoscopic Gastrostomy*.

Gastrula

An early embryo stage formed after gastrulation,

when cell layers reorganize into ectoderm, mesoderm, and endoderm that give rise to body tissues.

Gastrulation

An early stage of embryo development in which cells move and reorganize into three layers that later form all major tissues and organs.

Gated Blood Pool Scan

A radionuclide cardiac study, also called radionuclide ventriculography or MUGA, that uses ECG-gated images of labeled blood to measure ventricular ejection fraction and assess ventricular wall motion. It is used selectively when quantitative ventricular function is needed.

Gatifloxacin

Gatifloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; systemic use is restricted in many settings because of dysglycaemia and other class toxicities, while ophthalmic use remains available in some regions.

Gaucher Disease

An inherited condition in which a missing or weak enzyme lets fatty substances build up in cells. It can enlarge the liver and spleen and cause anemia, easy bruising, low platelets, or bone pain. Some forms also damage the brain and nerves. The condition is usually caused by changes in the *GBA1* gene.

Gaucher-Schlagenhaufer

Alternate name; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Gaucher's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Gaucher Splenomegaly

Alternate name; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Gaultheria Oil

Oil of wintergreen, an essential oil containing concentrated methyl salicylate. It may be used in small amounts in topical products, but swallowing even a small amount can cause serious salicylate poisoning, especially in children.

Gauss

A unit of magnetic flux density equal to 10^{-4} tesla, used in physics, imaging, and descriptions of magnetic fields.

Gauze

A woven or nonwoven material used to clean, dress, pack, or absorb fluid from a wound. It may be sterile or nonsterile and comes in several forms.

Gavage

Giving liquid food or medicine through a tube into the stomach. It is used when swallowing is unsafe or oral intake is inadequate, including for premature infants who cannot coordinate sucking, swallowing, and breathing.

Gayet-Wernicke Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Wernicke Encephalopathy*.

Gaze Palsy

An inability to move both eyes conjugately in a particular direction (horizontal, vertical, or upgaze), caused by lesions involving the cortical frontal eye fields, the paramedian pontine reticular formation (PPRF), or the midbrain rostral interstitial nucleus of the medial longitudinal fasciculus (riMLF).

Alternate Names:
Conjugate Gaze Palsy; Ocular Conjugate Palsy

GBM

Abbreviation for glioblastoma, an aggressive adult-type diffuse glioma classified as glioblastoma, IDH-wildtype. It can grow quickly and cause headache, seizures, weakness, or changes in speech, memory, or behavior. *Glioblastoma multiforme* is a historical name.

Alternate Names:
Glioblastoma

Gefitinib

An oral epidermal growth factor receptor tyrosine-kinase inhibitor used for selected advanced non-

small-cell lung cancers with activating EGFR mutations.

Gegenhalten

A velocity-independent, variable increase in resistance to passive limb movement in which the patient involuntarily opposes the examiner's manipulation with a force proportional to that applied by the examiner, commonly observed in diffuse frontal lobe disease, dementia, and metabolic encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Paratonia; Oppositional Paratonia

Geiger Counter

An instrument that detects and measures ionizing radiation. It can identify radioactive contamination or exposure, but its readings do not by themselves show how much biological harm the radiation caused.

Gel

A semisolid preparation in which liquid is held in a soft network. Gels may be applied to the skin, eyes, mouth, or other areas to soothe tissue, deliver medicine, or form a protective layer.

Gelastic Seizure

A rare seizure that causes sudden, repeated bursts of laughter without feeling amused. It is often linked to a small growth called a hypothalamic hamartoma, but other brain conditions can also cause it.

Gelatin

Gelatin is a protein made from collagen and used in foods, medicines, capsules, and some medical materials.

Gelatin Sponge

A sterile gelatin material placed during surgery to help control bleeding by supporting clot formation. It is gradually absorbed; swelling or infection can rarely occur.

Gel Electrophoresis

Gel electrophoresis separates DNA, RNA, or proteins by moving them through a gel in an electric field, usually according to size and charge.

Gelineau Syndrome

A sleep disorder causing repeated, uncontrollable daytime sleep episodes. Some people also have sudden muscle weakness triggered by emotion, sleep paralysis, or vivid dream-like experiences while falling asleep or waking.

Gemcitabine

A chemotherapy medicine that becomes active inside cells and interferes with DNA production, slowing or killing rapidly dividing cancer cells. It is used for several cancers and may cause low blood counts, nausea, rash, or organ toxicity.

Gemcitabine Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride form of gemcitabine, a chemotherapy medicine that interferes with DNA production in dividing cells. It is used for several cancers; important risks include infection from low blood counts and treatment-related organ injury.

Gemella

Gemella is a group of bacteria that normally may inhabit the mouth and upper airway but can rarely cause serious infections, including bloodstream infection.

Gemfibrozil

A medicine that lowers very high blood triglycerides and may reduce the risk of pancreatitis. It changes how the liver processes fats but can interact with statins and increase the risk of serious muscle injury.

Gemifloxacin

An antibiotic in the fluoroquinolone group used for selected bacterial respiratory infections. It can cause nausea and, rarely, tendon injury, nerve symptoms, abnormal heart rhythm, severe diarrhea, or dangerous allergic reactions.

Gemination

An attempt by one developing tooth bud to divide,

producing a large tooth with a split or partly divided crown. The total number of teeth is usually normal, and dental assessment guides treatment.

Gemistocytic Astrocytoma

A former histologic variant of diffuse astrocytoma composed partly of gemistocytic astrocytes. The term is now used mainly descriptively because integrated molecular classification determines the modern tumor diagnosis and grade.

Gemtuzumab Ozogamicin

An antibody-linked chemotherapy medicine used for selected acute myeloid leukemia. The antibody attaches to CD33-positive leukemia cells and delivers a toxic drug; liver injury, infusion reactions, and low blood counts are important risks.

Gender

A social, cultural, and personal concept involving identity, roles, expression, and expectations. Gender is related to, but distinct from, sex characteristics and sexual orientation.

Gender-Affirming Surgery

Surgical procedures intended to align physical characteristics with a person's gender identity. Procedures may involve the chest, face, voice, or external genitalia and are individualized according to anatomy, goals, health, and informed consent.

Gender Dysphoria

Clinically significant distress or impairment associated with incongruence between a person's experienced or expressed gender and sex assigned at birth. Having a gender identity different from sex assigned at birth does not by itself constitute gender dysphoria.

Gender Identity

A person's internal sense of being a woman, man, both, neither, or another gender, which may or may not correspond to sex assigned at birth.

Gender Incongruence

A difference between a person's experienced or expressed gender and sex assigned at birth. Gender incongruence is a descriptive term and does not by itself imply distress, impairment, or a mental disorder.

Gene

A section of DNA that contains instructions for making a functional product, usually a protein or RNA. Genes are arranged at specific locations on chromosomes and influence inherited traits and cell function.

Gene Amplification

An increase in the number of copies of a gene or genomic region, which can raise gene expression and drive some inherited conditions or cancers.

Gene Conversion

A nonreciprocal transfer of sequence information from one DNA region to a homologous region, potentially changing an allele during recombination or repair.

Gene Deletion

Loss of part or all of a gene from DNA, potentially abolishing its product or altering dosage and causing disease when clinically significant.

Gene Dosage

The number of functional copies of a gene and the amount of product they produce, influenced by deletions, duplications, chromosome number, and regulation.

Gene Duplication

An extra copy of a gene created by replication or rearrangement, which may have no effect, alter dosage, or provide material for new gene function.

Gene-Environment Interaction

A gene-environment interaction occurs when an environmental exposure changes disease risk differently according to a person's genotype, so inherited sus-

ceptibility and exposure jointly influence phenotype.

Gene Expression

The process by which a cell uses information in a gene to make RNA or protein. Cells control when and how strongly genes are expressed, allowing different tissues to develop and perform specialized functions.

Gene Frequency

The proportion of all gene copies in a population that carry a particular version, or allele, of that gene. It describes population genetics and does not by itself predict an individual's disease risk.

Gene Fusion

A hybrid gene formed when segments of two separate genes join, sometimes producing an abnormal protein that drives cancer or other disease.

Gene Modification

An intentional or naturally occurring alteration of DNA sequence or gene regulation that changes cellular function or inherited traits.

Gene-Modified

Describing cells or organisms whose genetic material has been deliberately altered using recombinant DNA or genome-editing methods.

Gene Mutation

A permanent change in the DNA sequence of a gene, which may be harmless, beneficial, or pathogenic depending on its effect and inheritance.

Gene Panel

A genetic test that examines a selected group of genes linked to a person's symptoms or suspected condition. It can provide focused results but may miss changes in genes or DNA regions not included in the panel.

General Anesthesia

A controlled, temporary state of unconsciousness produced by medicines so a person does not feel or remember a procedure. Breathing, blood pressure, heart rate, and other body functions are monitored throughout.

General Anesthetic

A medicine used to produce a controlled, reversible state of unconsciousness and lack of awareness during surgery or another procedure. It may be combined with separate medicines for pain relief or muscle relaxation; breathing and other vital functions require monitoring.

Alternate Names:
General Anesthetics

Generalised

British spelling; see *Generalized*.

Generalized

Distributed widely or involving most or all of a body region, system, or population rather than being confined to one focus.

Generalized Anxiety Disorder

A mental-health disorder involving excessive, difficult-to-control worry about several areas of life on most days for at least six months. Restlessness, tiredness, poor concentration, irritability, muscle tension, and sleep problems may occur.

Generalized Anxiety Disorder (GAD)

Alternate name; see *Generalized Anxiety Disorder*.

Generalized Anxiety Disorder In Children

Excessive, difficult-to-control worry about several areas of life on most days for at least six months, causing distress or interfering with a child's functioning. Restlessness, fatigue, difficulty concentrating, irritability, muscle tension, and sleep disturbance may occur.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric GAD; Childhood Generalized Anxiety

Generalized Essential Telangiectasia

Widespread fine superficial dilated vessels without

an identifiable underlying systemic disease or localized cause. They are usually asymptomatic; a new or rapidly progressive pattern can be associated with medicines, connective-tissue disease, liver disease, or other secondary causes.

Generalized Granuloma Annulare

A widespread skin condition causing many small, skin-colored, red, or purple bumps over the trunk and limbs. It may be associated with diabetes and can last longer than localized granuloma annulare.

Generalized Lipodystrophy

A disorder with near-total loss of adipose tissue, severe insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, fatty liver, and abnormal fat deposition in other tissues.

Generalized Lymphadenopathy

Enlargement of lymph nodes in several separate areas of the body. It may result from an infection, an immune disorder, or a blood cancer and differs from swelling limited to one area.

Alternate Names:
Diffuse Lymphadenopathy; Systemic Lymphadenopathy

Generalized-Onset Seizure

Older classification term; see *Generalized Seizure*.

Generalized Seizure

A seizure arising within and rapidly engaging networks distributed across both sides of the brain. It may appear to start in one area or have asymmetric movements; visible symptoms alone do not determine whether onset is focal or generalized.

Generalized Tonic-Clonic Seizure

A seizure causing loss of consciousness, stiffening of the whole body, and then repeated jerking of the limbs. Confusion and sleepiness often follow; a seizure lasting five minutes or longer is prolonged.

Generalized Weakness

Reduced strength affecting multiple body regions, caused by systemic illness, metabolic or electrolyte disturbance, medication, infection, muscle disease, nerve disease, neuromuscular-junction disease, or brain or spinal-cord disease. It may occur with speech, facial, breathing, or walking difficulty.

General Paresis

A late form of neurosyphilis affecting the brain. It can gradually cause memory loss, personality or mood changes, poor judgment, tremor, weakness, or difficulty walking.

Alternate Names:
General Paresis of the Insane; Paralytic Dementia

General Surgery

A surgical specialty concerned with a broad range of conditions, particularly those involving the abdomen, digestive tract, breast, endocrine glands, skin, and soft tissues. It also includes surgical care of many injuries and urgent conditions.

Generator

A device that produces a short-lived radioactive substance from a longer-lived one for nuclear-medicine tests. The product is separated, checked for purity and sterility, and then used to make a tracer.

Gene Rearrangement

Reorganization of DNA segments within or between chromosomes that can alter gene structure, expression, immune-receptor diversity, or cancer biology.

Generic

Describing a medicine by its active ingredient rather than a brand name; an approved generic drug must meet applicable standards for quality and therapeutic equivalence to its reference product.

Genes

Sections of DNA that contain instructions for making proteins or functional RNA. They are arranged on chromosomes and influence inherited traits, cell activity, disease risk, and responses to some treatments.

Gene Silencing

Reduction or stopping of a gene's activity through DNA changes, chromatin control, RNA interference, or other processes that limit protein production.

Genesis

The origin, formation, or development of something, such as a disease, organ, symptom, or process. Understanding its genesis can help explain causes, risk factors, progression, prevention, and treatment.

Gene Targeting

A molecular method that changes a chosen genomic locus through homologous recombination or engineered editing to study or alter gene function.

Gene Therapy

Treatment that changes DNA, RNA, or gene activity in a person's cells to treat disease. It may add a gene, switch off a harmful gene, replace a faulty gene, or edit DNA. Changes may be made inside the body or in cells changed outside the body and then returned.

Genetic Anticipation

Earlier onset or increasing severity of a hereditary disorder in successive generations, often caused by expansion of unstable repeated DNA sequences.

Genetic Carrier

A person who carries a disease-associated genetic variant and may pass it to children. Carriers of one variant for an autosomal recessive condition usually do not have that condition, although this is not true for every inherited disorder.

Genetic Code

The rules cells use to read genetic instructions in groups of three DNA or RNA building blocks. Each group directs the cell to add a particular amino acid to a protein or to stop making the protein.

Genetic Counseling

A professional discussion that explains how inherited factors may affect a person or family. It may cover risk, testing choices, results, reproductive options, emotional support, and implications for relatives.

Genetic Counselling

Alternate spelling; see *Genetic Counseling*.

Genetic Counselor

A trained health professional who explains inherited conditions, estimates genetic risk, discusses testing, and helps patients and families understand results and choices. They may coordinate testing of relatives when appropriate.

Genetic Disease

Alternate name; see *Genetic Disorder*.

Genetic Disorder

A disease or disorder caused wholly or partly by a pathogenic change in genetic material. The change may involve one or more genes, chromosome number or structure, mitochondrial DNA, or gene regulation. It may be inherited through germline DNA, arise de novo, or occur only in certain tissues as a somatic change. Some conditions also result from interactions among multiple genetic variants and environmental factors; not every genetic change causes disease.

Genetic Drift

Random changes in allele frequencies from one generation to the next, especially in small populations, independent of natural selection.

Genetic Engineering

Deliberate changing, adding, removing, or transferring genetic material using laboratory methods. It supports research, diagnosis, treatment development, agriculture, and biotechnology but requires careful assessment of safety, ethics, and unintended effects.

Genetic Heterogeneity

The situation in which similar features or the same disease can result from different genetic causes. Different genes or different changes within one gene

may produce overlapping effects.

Genetic Linkage

The tendency of nearby genes or DNA markers on the same chromosome to be inherited together because crossing over is less likely between them.

Genetic Marker

A detectable DNA variation or feature used to track inheritance, identify a chromosome region, assess disease risk, or distinguish samples.

Genetic Polymorphism

A common DNA variation with at least two alleles in a population, which may influence traits, drug response, or disease susceptibility.

Genetic Profile

A set of genetic variants or DNA markers describing an individual, tumor, organism, or sample for diagnosis, risk assessment, identification, or research.

Genetic Recombination

Exchange or rearrangement of DNA segments that creates new allele combinations during meiosis, repair, immune-cell development, or laboratory manipulation.

Genetics

Genetics is the study of genes, heredity, genetic variation, and how DNA and gene regulation influence traits, disease risk, diagnosis, and treatment response.

Genetic Screening

Testing people or groups without symptoms to identify an increased chance of a genetic condition or a risk of passing one to children. Examples include newborn and carrier screening; a positive screening result generally requires diagnostic testing.

Genetic Sequencing

Determination of the order of DNA bases in a selected gene or larger DNA region. Sequencing can identify genetic variants, but findings must be interpreted in light of the clinical question and other evidence.

Alternate Names:
DNA Sequencing

Genetic Sonogram

An older term for a detailed pregnancy ultrasound used to examine fetal anatomy and look for findings associated with some chromosome conditions. Ultrasound does not diagnose or exclude all genetic conditions.

Genetic Susceptibility

Inherited tendency to develop a disease or respond to an exposure, which usually modifies risk rather than determining outcome alone.

Genetic Technique

A laboratory method used to detect, amplify, sequence, edit, compare, or otherwise analyze DNA, RNA, chromosomes, or gene expression.

Genetic Testing

Analysis of DNA or chromosomes to assess disease risk, explain symptoms, identify carriers, or guide treatment. Results may also provide information about inherited traits and conditions affecting relatives.

Genetic Transcription

The first step in using a gene: an enzyme copies information from DNA into RNA. The RNA may then guide protein production or perform another function inside the cell.

Genetic Variant Of Uncertain Significance

A DNA change whose effect on health is not yet known. It does not by itself show that a person has a disease or predict future disease and may later be classified as harmless or disease-causing as evidence improves.

Gene Transfer

Movement of genetic material into a cell or organism,

naturally or through laboratory vectors, potentially changing gene expression or correcting a defect.

Geniculate Body

One of two paired relay structures in the brain. The lateral geniculate body processes visual signals, while the medial geniculate body processes hearing signals before sending them to the cerebral cortex.

Geniculate Ganglion

An L-shaped sensory ganglion of the facial nerve (cranial nerve VII) located within the facial canal of the temporal bone, housing the primary pseudounipolar sensory neuronal cell bodies conveying special taste sensation from the anterior two-thirds of the tongue (via chorda tympani).

Genital

Pertaining or relating to the anatomical organs and physiological structures of reproduction and external sexuality. In embryology, male and female external genitalia develop from common, bipotential primordial precursors: the genital tubercle (giving rise to the glans penis in males and glans clitoridis in females), urogenital folds (ventral shaft of the penis and spongiform urethra in males; labia minora in females), and labioscrotal swellings (scrotum in males under dihydrotestosterone stimulation; labia majora in females in the absence of androgens). Genital disorders encompass infectious, congenital, dermatological, and neoplastic conditions affecting the vulva, vagina, cervix, uterus, ovaries, fallopian tubes, penis, scrotum, testes, or prostate.

Alternate Names:
Genitals; Reproductive Organs

Genital Edema

Swelling of genital tissues from fluid accumulation caused by infection, inflammation, allergy, trauma, venous or lymphatic obstruction, or systemic disease.

Genital Herpes

An infection of the genital or anal area caused by herpes simplex virus type 1 or type 2 (HSV-1 or HSV-2). It spreads mainly through sexual skin-to-skin contact and can be transmitted even when no sores are present. It may cause painful blisters or ulcers, burning urination, swollen glands, or no symptoms; outbreaks can recur. Infection during pregnancy can threaten the newborn.

Genital Herpes in Pregnancy

Genital herpes caused by HSV-1 or HSV-2 can be acquired, recur, or be transmitted to the newborn during pregnancy or delivery. Management considers timing of infection, lesions or prodrome at labor, antiviral therapy, and delivery planning to reduce neonatal transmission.

Genital Herpes in Women

Herpes simplex virus infection of the female genitalia, causing painful blisters or ulcers. It may have no symptoms. Antiviral treatment can reduce symptoms and transmission; infection during pregnancy can affect the newborn.

Alternate Names:
Female Genital Herpes

Genitalia

The external and internal reproductive organs. The term includes the vulva and vagina, or the penis, scrotum, and associated structures, together with the gonads and reproductive ducts when used broadly; anatomy varies with sex, age, and developmental stage.

Genital Injury

Damage to the external or internal genital tissues from childbirth, accidents, sexual contact, assault, medical procedures, or disease. It may cause pain, swelling, bleeding, or difficulty urinating.

Genital Mycoplasmas

Mycoplasma species found in the genital or urinary tract. *Mycoplasma genitalium* is a sexually transmitted infection associated with urethritis, cervicitis, and pelvic inflammatory disease; other species, such as *M. hominis*, may colonize the tract without causing disease.

Genital Prolapse

The dropping or bulging of one or more pelvic organs (such as the bladder, uterus, or rectum) into or through the vagina due to weakening of the pelvic floor muscles and supporting tissues. It commonly causes a feeling of a vaginal bulge or heaviness, lower back discomfort, and urinary or bowel difficulties; risks include vaginal childbirth, aging, menopause, and chronic straining.

Alternate Names:
Pelvic Organ Prolapse; Urogenital Prolapse

Genitals

Plural form; see *Genital*.

Genital System

The organs involved in reproduction and sexual function, including the gonads, reproductive ducts, accessory glands, and external genital structures. Anatomy differs between individuals and changes with development and age.

Genital Ulcer

An open sore on the skin or moist lining of the genitals. Causes include infections such as herpes or syphilis, skin conditions, injury, or cancer. Testing may be needed to find the cause.

Genital Ulcer Disease

A syndrome involving one or more ulcers of the genital or perianal skin or mucosa. Causes include sexually transmitted infections such as herpes simplex, syphilis, and chancroid, as well as noninfectious conditions.

Alternate Names:
GUD

Genital Wart

Alternate singular form; see *Genital Warts*.

Genital Warts

Benign growths of genital or anal skin or mucosa caused by human papillomavirus (HPV), most often types 6 or 11. They may be flat, raised, or cauliflower-like and are often asymptomatic. They can recur and may occur at multiple anogenital sites.

Alternate Names:
Condylomata Acuminata; Anogenital Warts

Genitofemoral Nerve

A branch of the lumbar plexus (arising from L1 and L2 nerve roots) that pierces the anterior surface of the psoas major muscle and divides into a genital branch (innervating the cremaster muscle and scrotal/labial skin; mediating the cremasteric reflex) and a femoral branch (cutaneous sensation to the anterior upper thigh).

Genito-Pelvic Pain/Penetration Disorder

Persistent or recurrent difficulty with vaginal penetration, including pain, fear or anxiety about pain, involuntary pelvic-floor tightening, or pain during attempted penetration, causing clinically significant distress. Causes may include pelvic-floor problems, infection, hormonal changes, injury, or emotional factors.

Genitourinary

Relating to the urinary system and the reproductive organs, which share developmental and anatomical relationships.

Genitourinary Fistula

Alternate name for urogenital fistula, an abnormal connection between the urinary and genital tracts.

Genito-Urinary Medicine

The medical specialty concerned with urinary and reproductive health. It includes evaluation and treatment of urinary infections, sexual health problems, sexually transmitted infections, and some reproductive conditions.

Genitourinary Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the urinary or reproductive organs, such as the kidney, bladder, prostate, testis, ovary, or uterus. It may be benign or cancerous; examination, imaging, and sometimes biopsy identify its nature.

Genitourinary Syndrome Of Menopause

A group of changes in the genital and urinary tissues after menopause, caused mainly by lower estrogen levels. It may include vaginal dryness, burning, pain during sex, urinary urgency, painful urination, or repeated urinary infections.

Genitourinary Tract

The combined urinary and reproductive organs and their associated ducts.

Genodermatoses

Inherited disorders that mainly affect the skin, hair, nails, sweat glands, or related organs. Examples include inherited scaling disorders, blistering diseases, and some neurocutaneous syndromes; severity varies widely.

Genome

The complete genetic material of an organism, including genes and DNA that does not directly code proteins. It contains instructions influencing development, body function, inherited traits, disease risk, and treatment response.

Genomic Imprinting

A pattern in which a gene's activity depends on whether its copy came from the mother or father. Abnormal imprinting can cause conditions such as Prader–Willi or Angelman syndrome.

Genomic Instability

An increased tendency for DNA changes, chromosome damage, and mutations to accumulate, contributing to cancer development, treatment resistance, and disease progression.

Genomics

The study of an organism's complete genetic material, including its DNA sequence, variation, activity, and interaction with disease and treatment. It supports research, diagnosis, risk assessment, and personalized care.

Genotoxicity

The ability of a substance or physical agent to damage genetic material. Genotoxicity may cause mutations or chromosome damage, but a positive test does not by itself establish that an agent causes cancer in humans.

Genotype

A person's genetic makeup, meaning the versions of one or more genes they carry. The genotype helps influence observable traits and disease risk together with other genes and environmental factors.

Genotype Determination

Genotype determination is the use of laboratory testing to identify an individual's genetic variants or alleles at one or more locations.

Genotype-Phenotype Correlation

The relationship between a person's genetic makeup and the observable features, severity, age of onset, or clinical course of a condition; correlations may be incomplete because other genetic and environmental factors contribute.

Gentamicin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic that interferes with bacterial protein production. It can injure the kidneys or hearing and is used with dose and blood-level monitoring.

Gentamicin Sulfate

The sulfate salt of gentamicin, an aminoglycoside antibiotic that interferes with bacterial protein production. It can injure the kidneys or hearing and is used with careful dosing and monitoring.

Gentian

A plant of the Gentiana genus whose roots or other parts have been used in herbal preparations, traditionally as a bitter digestive; clinical evidence and product quality vary.

Gentian Violet

A purple antiseptic and dye with antifungal and

antibacterial activity, used in selected topical applications but capable of irritating tissue and staining skin.

Genu

The knee or a knee-shaped part of an anatomical structure; the term also describes a bend, such as the genu of the corpus callosum.

Genu Recurvatum

Hyperextension of the knee beyond the usual straight position, caused by laxity, deformity, muscle imbalance, neurologic disease, or injury.

Genu Valgum

An alignment abnormality in which the knees angle inward and may touch while the ankles remain apart. It may be developmental or caused by bone, joint, or metabolic disease.

Alternate Names:
Knock-Knees; Tibial Valgus

Genu Varum

Outward bowing of the legs, commonly called bowlegs. It is often normal in young children and improves with growth, but persistent, worsening, unequal, painful, or severe bowing may result from rickets, growth-plate disease, or another condition.

Alternate Names:
Bowlegs; Bandy Legs

Geographic Atrophy

An advanced form of dry age-related macular degeneration in which areas of light-sensing and supporting cells in the center of the retina are permanently lost. It causes slowly worsening blind spots and loss of detailed central vision.

Geographic Tongue

A harmless condition in which smooth red patches with pale borders appear and change location on the tongue. It usually causes no symptoms but may make spicy or acidic foods sting.

Alternate Names:
Benign Migratory Glossitis

Geophagia

Persistent eating of soil or other nonfood substances; it may cause poisoning, infection, intestinal obstruction, or iron-deficiency anemia.

Geophagy

The deliberate ingestion of soil or clay; it may cause lead or parasite exposure, gastrointestinal obstruction, or iron-deficiency anemia and can occur with pica.

Geotrichum

Geotrichum is a genus of fungi that may colonize humans and can rarely cause superficial or invasive infection, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Geriatric Assessment

A broad review of an older person's medical conditions, medicines, mobility, memory, mood, daily activities, nutrition, safety, home situation, and goals. It identifies treatable problems and guides an individualized care plan.

Geriatric Bioethics

The study of ethical questions in the care of older adults, including decision-making capacity, consent, use of surrogate decision-makers, treatment goals, and fair access to care.

Geriatric Dentistry

Dental care adapted to the needs of older adults, including tooth decay, gum disease, dry mouth, dentures, swallowing concerns, medicine effects, and examination for oral cancer.

Geriatric Depression

Depression in an older adult may cause low mood, loss of interest, fatigue, sleep or appetite changes, slowed thinking, physical complaints, or memory problems. Medical illness, medicines, isolation, and bereavement may contribute.

Alternate Names:
Late-Life Depression; Depression in the Elderly

Geriatric Depression Scale

A questionnaire used to screen older adults for symptoms of depression. It can identify people with possible depression, but a positive result does not by itself establish depression or explain its cause.

Geriatric Dysphagia

Difficulty swallowing in an older adult. It may cause coughing or choking during meals, food remaining in the mouth, weight loss, dehydration, or aspiration and can result from stroke, dementia, muscle disease, blockage, or medicines.

Geriatric Hospitalization

Hospital care for an older adult, with attention to medical illness as well as mobility, medicines, nutrition, hearing, vision, and cognition. Preventing falls, delirium, pressure injuries, and loss of independence supports safer recovery.

Geriatrician

A physician specializing in the health care of older adults, including complex illness, multiple conditions, medications, function, and goals of care.

Geriatric Infection

Infection in an older adult may cause confusion, weakness, reduced appetite, or a fall without causing fever. Common sites include the urine, lungs, skin, and bloodstream; illness can worsen quickly.

Alternate Names:
Infection in the Elderly; Late-Life Infection

Geriatric Informed Consent

The process of confirming that an older adult with decision-making capacity understands a proposed intervention, its benefits, risks, and alternatives and makes a voluntary choice. Age alone does not determine decision-making capacity.

Geriatric Medical Ethics

Ethical decision-making in the care of older adults, including respect for the person's wishes, decision-making capacity, likely benefits and harms, fairness, privacy, and appropriate involvement of family or caregivers.

Geriatric Neurology

The neurology subspecialty concerned with nervous-system disorders in older adults. It considers how aging, frailty, other illnesses, and medicines affect diagnosis and function, and commonly addresses dementia, stroke, movement disorders, seizures, and gait problems.

Geriatric Nursing

Nursing care focused on the health, function, medication safety, cognition, mobility, and goals of older adults.

Geriatric Nutrition

Nutrition care for older adults that considers aging, illness, medicines, frailty, dental or swallowing problems, appetite, and access to food. Goals include maintaining strength, muscle, hydration, function, and quality of life.

Geriatric Osteoarthritis

Osteoarthritis occurring in later life, commonly affecting the knees, hips, hands, or spine and causing joint pain, stiffness, and reduced movement. Management may include exercise, weight management, medicines, assistive measures, or joint replacement when appropriate.

Alternate Names:
Age-Related Osteoarthritis

Geriatric Rehabilitation

Therapy that helps an older adult regain or maintain movement, strength, independence, and safety after illness, injury, surgery, or functional decline. The plan is adapted to health, abilities, goals, and support needs.

Geriatrics

The medical specialty focused on health, function, independence, and quality of life in older adults. Care considers multiple illnesses, medicines, memory, mobility, nutrition, mood, safety, goals, and support.

Geriatric Screening

Screening for diseases or health risks in older adults without related symptoms. The appropriate screening depends on age, health, life expectancy, preferences, and evidence of benefit.

Geriatric Sleep Changes

Changes in sleep timing, duration, or continuity that may occur with aging. Insomnia, sleep apnea, medicines, pain, and other illnesses can also cause sleep problems; these conditions are not an inevitable part of normal aging.

Geriatric Syndrome

A common problem in older adults caused by several interacting factors rather than one disease. Examples include falls, frailty, delirium, incontinence, immobility, and pressure injuries; causes may be medical, social, or both.

Geriatric Trauma

Injury in an older adult, often involving falls, fractures, head injury, or bleeding. Age-related frailty, osteoporosis, balance problems, and medicines that increase bleeding can make injuries more serious and recovery slower.

Germ

Alternate informal term; see *Microorganism*.

Germanium

A chemical element sometimes included in unproven health supplements. Germanium compounds have no established medical benefit and can cause kidney damage, nerve damage, or other serious toxicity when taken internally.

German Measles

Alternate name; see *Rubella*.

Alternate Names:
Rubella; Three-Day Measles

Germ Cell

A reproductive cell or precursor that gives rise to sperm or eggs and carries genetic material to the next generation.

Germ Cell Tumor

A tumor arising from cells that normally develop into sperm or eggs. It may occur in the testicles, ovaries, or other sites such as the chest or abdomen; some types are highly treatable with surgery, chemotherapy, or both.

Germ Cell Tumors

Alternate plural form; see *Germ Cell Tumor*.

Germ Cell Tumor Staging

Determination of the extent and risk of a germ-cell tumor using examination, imaging, tumor markers, surgical findings, and pathology. Stage and histologic type guide surgery, chemotherapy, surveillance, and prognosis.

Germinoma

A usually slow-growing germ-cell cancer that most often develops in the pineal or suprasellar area of the brain. Related tumors occur in the testicles or ovaries; treatment commonly uses radiation, chemotherapy, surgery, or combinations.

Germ Layer

One of the three early layers of an embryo—ectoderm, mesoderm, or endoderm—from which all major tissues and organs develop. Each layer gives rise to characteristic body structures during development.

Germline Mutation

A disease-causing genetic change in an egg, sperm, or their precursor cells that can be passed to children. It is usually present in nearly every cell of the person and may increase the risk of inherited disorders or cancer.

Germline Testing

Genetic testing of blood, saliva, or another sample to look for changes that may be inherited or passed to children. Results can affect the person's care, relatives, cancer screening, and reproductive

decisions.

Germline Variant

A DNA change present in cells that can give rise to eggs or sperm and therefore may be passed to children. It is usually present in most cells of the person, unlike a change limited to a tumor or other tissue.

Germ Theory Of Disease

The evidence-based principle that particular microorganisms can cause particular infectious diseases. It underlies infection control, vaccination, antimicrobial treatment, sterilization, and methods used to identify disease-causing organisms.

Gerontologist

A specialist studying aging and its biological, psychological, social, or economic effects. Gerontologists may work in research, healthcare, policy, counseling, education, housing, or community services for older people.

Gerstmann-Straussler-Scheinker Syndrome

A rare, autosomal dominant inherited prion disease caused by mutations in the PRNP gene (most commonly P102L), characterized pathologically by multicentric PrP-amyloid plaques throughout the cerebellum and cerebral cortex, presenting with slowly progressive cerebellar ataxia, spasticity, and late dementia.

Alternate Names:
GSS Syndrome; GSS Prion Disease

Gerstmann Syndrome

A neurological cognitive syndrome caused by a lesion of the dominant angular gyrus in the inferior parietal lobule (typically left hemisphere), characterized by the classic tetrad of agraphia (dysgraphia), acalculia (dyscalculia), finger agnosia, and right-left disorientation.

Alternate Names:
Angular Gyrus Syndrome; Dominant Parietal Lobe Syndrome

Gesell Developmental Schedules

Standardized developmental assessment schedules that describe expected motor, language, adaptive, and social milestones in children; they support screening but do not by themselves diagnose a disorder.

Gestation

The period of pregnancy during which an embryo and fetus develop in the uterus. Pregnancy is usually dated as about 40 weeks from the first day of the last menstrual period, or about 38 weeks from fertilization.

Gestational Age

The length of a pregnancy measured in weeks from the first day of the last menstrual period. It is usually about two weeks longer than the time since fertilization and helps estimate development, due date, and appropriate care.

Alternate Names:
Menstrual Age

Gestational Diabetes

A type of diabetes that first develops during pregnancy, usually detected in the second or third trimester. During pregnancy, hormones produced by the placenta make the body's cells more resistant to insulin. If the mother's pancreas cannot produce enough extra insulin to overcome this resistance, blood sugar levels rise above normal. While blood sugar usually returns to normal after delivery, the condition increases the risk of pregnancy complications and raises the mother's future risk of developing type 2 diabetes.

Alternate Names:
GDM; Gestational Diabetes Mellitus

Gestational Diabetes Mellitus

Alternate medical term; see *Gestational Diabetes*.

Gestational Hypertension

New-onset high blood pressure after 20 weeks of pregnancy without protein in the urine or other features of preeclampsia. It may later develop into preeclampsia.

Gestational Pyelonephritis

A kidney infection occurring during pregnancy, usually causing fever, flank pain, nausea, or urinary symptoms. It can lead to sepsis, preterm labor, or breathing complications.

Alternate Names:
Pyelonephritis in Pregnancy; Gravid Kidney Infection

Gestational Choriocarcinoma

A fast-growing cancer of placenta-forming cells that develops after a pregnancy, most often after a molar pregnancy but sometimes after a normal pregnancy, miscarriage, abortion, or pregnancy outside the uterus. It can invade the uterine wall and spread through the blood to other organs. It usually produces the pregnancy hormone hCG.

Gestational Sac

The first fluid-filled structure usually seen inside the uterus on an early pregnancy ultrasound. Its size and appearance help estimate pregnancy age and assess early development, but an early scan may not yet show an embryo.

Gestational Trophoblastic Disease

A group of uncommon conditions caused by abnormal growth of cells that normally help form the placenta. It includes molar pregnancy and some pregnancy-related cancers and may cause unusually high pregnancy hormone levels, bleeding, or a uterus larger than expected.

Gestational Trophoblastic Neoplasia

Persistent or cancerous growth of placenta-related cells after a pregnancy, miscarriage, abortion, or molar pregnancy. It is often detected by pregnancy-hormone levels that remain high or rise and is usually very responsive to specialist cancer treatment.

Gestation Period

Alternate name; see *Gestation*.

GFR

Abbreviation for glomerular filtration rate; see *Glomerular Filtration Rate*.

GHD

Abbreviation; see *Growth Hormone Deficiency*.

Ghon Complex

The combination of a primary tuberculous lung focus (Ghon focus) and caseous granulomatous lymphadenitis in the draining regional hilar or mediastinal lymph nodes, representing the hallmark of primary pulmonary tuberculosis that often undergoes fibrocalcification.

Alternate Names:
Primary Tuberculous Complex

Ghon Focus

A primary granulomatous tuberculous pulmonary lesion consisting of a circumscribed area of caseous necrosis typically located subpleurally in the mid-to-lower lung zone, representing the initial site of Mycobacterium tuberculosis infection.

Alternate Names:
Primary Focus of Ghon; Subpleural Tuberculous Focus

Ghrelin

A hormone produced mainly in the stomach that increases hunger and helps regulate energy balance. It also stimulates growth-hormone release and changes with eating, fasting, sleep, and body weight.

Gianotti Crosti Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Gianotti-Crosti Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
Papular Acrodermatitis of Childhood; Infantile Lichenoid Acrodermatitis

Gianotti-Crosti Syndrome

A childhood skin condition characterized by a papular or papulovesicular rash on the face, buttocks, and extremities, often following viral infections (EBV, hepatitis B, CMV). Self-limited, lasting 2-8 weeks. Also called papular acrodermatitis of childhood.

Giant Axonal Disease

Alternate name; see *Giant Axonal Neuropathy*.

Giant Axonal Neuropathy

A rare inherited disorder in which abnormal giant nerve fibers develop, causing progressive peripheral neuropathy, weakness, loss of sensation, poor coordination, and sometimes changes in hair or skin. Onset and severity vary.

Giant Cell Arteritis

Inflammation of arteries, usually in people over 50, often affecting vessels near the temples and eyes. It can cause new headache, scalp tenderness, jaw pain while chewing, or vision changes and may permanently damage sight.

Giant Cell Arteritis Emergency

A severe presentation of suspected giant cell arteritis with visual symptoms, jaw or tongue pain during chewing, or reduced blood flow to the nervous system. It carries a risk of permanent visual loss.

Giant Cell Glioblastoma

A rare histologic variant of glioblastoma characterized by numerous large, often multinucleated tumor cells. It may cause headache, seizures, weakness, or changes in speech, vision, memory, or behavior, depending on location. Diagnosis uses brain imaging and tumor tissue analysis; treatment is coordinated by a neuro-oncology team.

Alternate Names:
Glioblastoma, Giant Cell; Monstrocellular Sarcoma

Giant Cell Interstitial Pneumonia

A rare occupational interstitial lung disease, usually associated with inhalation of hard-metal dust containing cobalt and tungsten carbide. It features multinucleated giant cells in the air spaces and can cause cough, breathlessness, and lung scarring.

Giant Cell Myocarditis

A rare, severe inflammation of the heart muscle caused by an abnormal immune reaction. It can weaken the heart and cause dangerous heart rhythms or heart failure.

Giant Cells

Large cells formed by fusion of macrophages or abnormal cellular growth, seen in granulomatous inflammation, foreign-body reactions, and some tumors.

Giant Cell Tumor

See *Giant Cell Tumor Of Bone*.

Giant Cell Tumor Of Bone

A usually noncancerous but locally aggressive bone tumor made up of abnormal cells and many large bone-resorbing cells. It usually occurs near the ends of long bones in adults after skeletal growth is complete. It can damage nearby bone, recur, and rarely spread to the lungs.

Alternate Names:
GCTB; Osteoclastoma

Giant Cell Tumor Of Soft Tissue

A usually low-grade soft-tissue neoplasm containing numerous osteoclast-like giant cells, most often arising in the extremities of adults and generally having a favorable outcome after excision.

Giant Cell Tumor Of Tendon Sheath

A common benign localized tenosynovial tumor, usually presenting as a slow-growing firm nodule on a finger or hand; recurrence can occur after excision.

Giant Congenital Nevus

A very large dark or brown skin mark present at birth. It may grow with the child and has a higher risk of melanoma than smaller birthmarks.

Alternate Names:
Giant Pigmented Nevus

Giant Coronary Aneurysm

An unusually large bulge in an artery supplying the heart. It can form a clot, reduce blood flow, or rarely rupture.

Giant Cyst of the Retina

A large fluid-filled retinal cystic lesion that can distort or damage the retina and impair vision. Evaluation typically requires a detailed eye examination and retinal imaging.

Giant Fibroadenoma

An uncommon clinical variant of benign breast fibroadenoma exceeding 5 cm in diameter or 500 grams in weight, characterized by rapid encapsulated proliferation of epithelial and stromal elements, frequently occurring during adolescence or pregnancy.

Giant Hypertrophic Gastritis

Severe thickening of the stomach lining and its folds, which can cause stomach pain, nausea, swelling, and loss of blood proteins. It may increase stomach-cancer risk.

Giant Lymph Node Hyperplasia

A rare condition in which lymph-node tissue grows excessively. It may affect one area or many parts of the body and can cause enlarged nodes, fever, fatigue, anemia, weight loss, or organ problems.

Alternate Names:
Castleman Disease; Angiofollicular Lymph Node Hyperplasia

Giant Platelet Syndrome

An inherited platelet disorder caused by deficiency of glycoprotein Ib/IX/V complex, resulting in large platelets and impaired platelet adhesion. Presents with mucocutaneous bleeding, thrombocytopenia, and giant platelets on blood smear.

Alternate Names:
Bernard-Soulier Syndrome; Platelet Glycoprotein Ib Deficiency

Giant Right Atrium

Marked enlargement of the heart's right upper chamber, usually from long-standing valve disease, a congenital heart defect, or abnormal rhythm. It can disturb the heartbeat, compress nearby structures, or allow clots to form and is assessed with heart imaging.

Giant Urticaria

Older term for angioedema, a sudden swelling of deeper skin or tissue beneath a mucous membrane; see *Angioedema*.

Giardia

A microscopic parasite that infects the small intestine and spreads through contaminated water, food, or hands. It can cause foul-smelling diarrhea, cramps, bloating, nausea, weight loss, or no symptoms.

Giardia Infection

An intestinal infection caused by Giardia parasites, usually spread through contaminated water, food, or contact with an infected person. It can cause prolonged foul-smelling diarrhea, cramps, bloating, weight loss, and poor nutrient absorption.

Giardia Lamblia

The parasite that causes giardiasis. It is swallowed in contaminated water, food, or material from an infected person and can cause foul-smelling diarrhea, abdominal cramps, gas, bloating, and weight loss.

Giardiasis

An intestinal infection caused by the parasite Giardia duodenalis. It spreads when contaminated water, food, surfaces, or material from an infected person is swallowed. It may cause diarrhea, foul-smelling or greasy stools, gas, abdominal cramps, nausea, bloating, weight loss, and poor nutrient absorption.

Gibbus Deformity

A sharp, angular, structural kyphosis of the spine produced by the anterior collapse or destruction of one or more adjacent vertebral bodies, classically seen in tuberculosis of the spine (Pott disease) or severe osteoporotic wedge fractures.

Alternate Names:
Pott Gibbus; Angular Kyphosis

Gibraltar Fever

An old name for brucellosis, an infection caused

by Brucella bacteria, usually acquired through unpasteurized dairy products or contact with infected animals.

Giemsa Stain

A laboratory dye used to show blood cells and some bacteria, parasites, and other organisms under a microscope. It can help identify malaria parasites and other infections in blood or tissue samples.

Gigabecquerel

A unit of radioactivity equal to one billion nuclear disintegrations per second. It measures the activity of a radioactive source, not directly the radiation dose absorbed by a person.

Gigantism

Excessive growth caused by too much growth hormone during childhood, before the bones finish lengthening. It usually results from a pituitary growth and causes unusual height and enlargement of body tissues.

Gigli Saw

A flexible wire saw used during some orthopedic, neurosurgical, or amputation procedures to cut bone. It is handled carefully to limit injury to nearby soft tissues.

Gilbert-Lereboullet Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Gilbert Syndrome*.

Gilbert's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Gilbert Syndrome*.

Gilbert's Syndrome

A common inherited condition in which the liver processes bilirubin slowly, causing occasional mild yellowing of the eyes, especially during illness, fasting, or stress.

Gilbert Syndrome

A common inherited condition in which the liver processes bilirubin more slowly than usual. It can cause occasional mild yellowing of the eyes or skin, especially during fasting, illness, dehydration, or stress, and usually does not harm the liver.

Gilles De La Tourette Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Tourette Syndrome*.

Gingiva

The firm pink tissue, commonly called the gums, that surrounds and protects the teeth and the bone around their roots. Healthy gingiva usually does not bleed with gentle brushing; redness, swelling, or bleeding may indicate gum disease.

Alternate Names:
Gums; Gingival Tissue

Gingiva Disease

Alternate name; see *Gum Disease*.

Gingival Bleeding

Alternate name; see *Gingival Hemorrhage*.

Gingival Disease

Alternate name; see *Gum Disease*.

Gingival Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the gums. It is often caused by gum inflammation or plaque, but injury, medicines, or bleeding problems can also cause it.

Gingival Hyperplasia

Overgrowth of gum tissue around the teeth. It can make cleaning difficult and may cause bleeding. Plaque, some medicines, inherited traits, and other health conditions can contribute.

Gingival Infections

Infections of the gums, usually involving bacteria in dental plaque. They can cause red, swollen, tender, or bleeding gums, bad breath, pus, and sometimes spreading facial swelling; persistent infection can damage gum tissue and supporting bone.

Gingival Margin

The edge of the gum tissue that surrounds and touches a tooth. It normally forms a shallow seal;

inflammation or recession can make it bleed or expose the tooth root.

Gingival Melanoma

A rare, aggressive cancer of pigment-producing cells in the gums. It may appear as a dark or non-pigmented lump, patch, or ulcer; biopsy can identify it.

Gingival Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the gums that may be reactive, benign, precancerous, or cancerous. It may cause persistent swelling, ulceration, bleeding, pain, or a lump; examination and sometimes biopsy identify its nature.

Gingival Overgrowth

Gingival overgrowth is an abnormal increase in gum tissue, which may be caused by medicines, inflammation, or systemic disease.

Gingival Pocket

The small space between the gum and tooth surface, measured during a dental examination. A persistently deep pocket usually indicates loss of attachment from periodontal disease and can collect plaque and bacteria.

Gingival Recession

Pulling back of the gums so that part of a tooth root becomes exposed. Gum disease, forceful brushing, tooth position, thin gum tissue, or treatment can cause it and may lead to sensitivity or root decay.

Gingivectomy

Surgical removal of gum tissue to treat overgrowth, reshape the gums, expose decay, or improve access. Possible complications include bleeding, sensitivity, infection, or gum recession.

Gingivitis

Mild gum disease, usually caused by plaque on the teeth. The gums may be red, swollen, or bleed during brushing. It can usually be reversed with good tooth cleaning; it does not always lead to periodontitis.

Gingivoplasty

Surgical reshaping or contouring of the gums to improve their form, remove diseased tissue, or make cleaning easier. It may be combined with gingivectomy or other periodontal treatment.

Gingivostomatitis

Common viral infection of the mouth and gums, most often caused by primary herpes simplex virus infection but also associated with other infections, trauma, or systemic disease. It may cause painful ulcers, swollen bleeding gums, fever, and difficulty eating or drinking.

Ginkgo Biloba

An herbal product derived from Ginkgo biloba leaves and marketed for cognitive or circulatory benefits; evidence is variable and it may increase bleeding risk or interact with medicines.

Ginseng

A group of plants whose roots are used in traditional medicine and dietary supplements; products vary in composition and may interact with medicines or affect blood glucose and clotting.

Ginseng Preparation

A product made from ginseng root and sold as a supplement. Products vary in strength and purity; interactions and side effects can occur.

Girdle Pain

Pain that wraps around the chest or abdomen in a band-like pattern. It may result from nerve irritation, spinal disease, shingles, muscle injury, or internal-organ disease.

Gitelman Syndrome

A rare inherited kidney disorder that causes the body to lose too much salt and magnesium in urine. It may lead to muscle cramps, weakness, tiredness, thirst, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Glabella

The smooth area of the forehead between the eyebrows and above the bridge of the nose.

Gland

An organ or group of cells that produces and releases substances. Endocrine glands release hormones into blood, while exocrine glands release substances through ducts or onto a surface.

Glanders

A serious infection caused by the bacterium *Burkholderia mallei*, which mainly affects horses and can rarely infect people exposed to infected animals or tissues. It may cause skin sores, fever, pneumonia, or bloodstream infection.

Glandular Fever

Alternate name; see *Infectious Mononucleosis*.

Glandular Plague

Alternate name; see *Bubonic Plague*.

Glans Penis

The expanded, sensitive distal end of the penis containing the external urethral opening and covered by the foreskin when present.

Glanzmann Thrombasthenia

An inherited platelet function disorder caused by deficiency or dysfunction of platelet glycoprotein IIb/IIIa, producing mucocutaneous bleeding despite a normal platelet count.

Glasgow Coma Scale

A bedside score describing a person's level of consciousness by assessing eye opening, speaking, and movement. Scores range from 3 to 15; lower scores indicate less response, but medicines and injuries can affect the result.

Glass Eye

A glass eye is an ocular prosthesis made to replace the appearance of an eye that is missing or severely damaged.

Glass Ionomer

A tooth-colored dental cement made from fluoroaluminosilicate glass and a polyalkenoic acid. It bonds chemically to enamel and dentin and releases fluoride. It is used as a filling, liner, or luting cement, especially in areas with lower chewing stress, because it is less wear-resistant than resin composites.

Alternate Names:
Glass Ionomer Cement; Glass-Ionomer Cement; Glass Polyalkenoate Cement

Glassy Cell Carcinoma

A rare poorly differentiated adenosquamous carcinoma of the cervix with distinctive glassy cytoplasm, prominent nucleoli, and aggressive clinical behavior.

Glaucoma

A group of eye conditions that damage the optic nerve, the vital cable that carries visual information from the eye to the brain. This damage is most commonly linked to abnormally high fluid pressure inside the eye (intraocular pressure), which builds up when the eye's natural drainage system becomes blocked or inefficient. Because it typically causes gradual, painless loss of peripheral (side) vision before affecting central vision, it can progress unnoticed without regular eye examinations.

Glaucoma Drainage Implant

A tube-and-plate device implanted in the eye to divert aqueous humor from the anterior chamber to a reservoir beneath the conjunctiva, lowering intraocular pressure.

Alternate Names:
Glaucoma Drainage Device; Glaucoma Drainage Implants

Glaucoma Surgery

Laser or incisional procedures that lower intraocular pressure by improving aqueous-humor outflow or, less often, reducing its production. They aim to limit further optic-nerve damage but cannot restore vision already lost.

Glaze Poisoning

Toxic exposure to ceramic or pottery glaze, which

may contain lead, cadmium, or other heavy metals. Symptoms depend on the metal involved and may include abdominal pain, neurological symptoms, and organ damage. Severe cases may be treated with chelation therapy.

Alternate Names:
Ceramic Glaze Poisoning

Gleason Grading System

A histological grading system for prostate cancer based on glandular pattern differentiation. Scores historically ranged from 2 to 10, but current reporting summarizes them as Grade Groups 1 to 5 (scores 6 to 10), with higher groups indicating more aggressive cancer. Used to guide treatment decisions and predict prognosis.

Gleason Score

A grading system estimating prostate cancer aggressiveness by examining tissue patterns under a microscope and combining the two most common patterns.

Gleason Tumor Grade

A histopathologic grade of prostate adenocarcinoma based on the architectural pattern of the tumor glands; it contributes to the Gleason score and Grade Group.

Glenn Procedure

A staged heart operation for some children born with only one effective pumping chamber. It connects the large vein returning blood from the upper body directly to the lung arteries, allowing blood to pick up oxygen while reducing the workload on the heart.

Alternate Names:
Bidirectional Glenn (BDG) Procedure; Cavopulmonary Anastomosis

Glenohumeral Joint

The ball-and-socket shoulder joint formed by the upper-arm bone and shoulder blade. It allows the arm to move in many directions but is relatively easy to dislocate because it sacrifices some stability for movement.

Glenoid

The shallow socket on the shoulder blade that joins the head of the upper-arm bone to form the shoulder joint. Its shape and surrounding labrum help balance mobility with stability.

Alternate Names:
Glenoid Cavity; Scapular Glenoid Fossa

Glenoid Cavity

Alternate name; see *Glenoid*.

Glenoid Labrum

A rim of fibrocartilage attached to the edge of the shoulder blade's glenoid cavity. It deepens the socket and helps stabilize the shoulder; the long-head biceps tendon attaches to its upper part.

Gliadin

A group of wheat storage proteins that, together with glutenin, form gluten; gliadin peptides trigger the immune response in celiac disease.

Glial Cell

A cell in the brain, spinal cord, or nerves that supports and protects nerve cells. Different types help keep nerve cells' surroundings stable, defend against infection, remove waste, or form an insulating layer around nerve fibers so signals travel quickly.

Glial Cells

Plural form; see *Glial Cell*.

Glial Fibrillary Acidic Protein

A protein found mainly in support cells of the brain and nervous system. Laboratory tests can use it to help identify some brain tumors or detect injury to support cells after brain trauma.

Alternate Names:
GFAP

Glibenclamide

An oral sulfonylurea medicine, also called glyburide, used for type 2 diabetes. It stimulates the pancreas to release insulin and can cause prolonged, sometimes severe low blood sugar and weight gain.

Gliclazide

Gliclazide is a sulfonylurea for type 2 diabetes that stimulates pancreatic beta-cell insulin release; hypoglycaemia, weight gain, and dose accumulation in organ impairment are important considerations.

GLIM Criteria

An international framework for diagnosing malnutrition. It considers body changes such as weight or muscle loss together with causes such as poor intake, poor absorption, or illness-related inflammation and grades severity according to the findings.

Glimepiride

An oral sulfonylurea medicine for type 2 diabetes that increases insulin release from functioning pancreatic beta cells. Low blood sugar is the main serious risk, particularly with missed meals, kidney disease, or other glucose-lowering medicines.

Glioblastoma

A fast-growing cancer that starts in the brain's support cells (glial cells) and spreads into nearby brain tissue. Symptoms depend on where it grows and may include headache, seizures, weakness, or changes in speech, memory, vision, balance, or behavior. *Glioblastoma multiforme* is an older name.

Glioblastoma Multiforme

Historical name; see *Glioblastoma*.

Glioma

A tumor that starts in glial cells in the brain or spinal cord. Glial cells support and protect nerve cells. Some gliomas grow slowly, while others grow quickly into nearby tissue. Symptoms depend on where the tumor grows and may include headache, seizures, weakness, or changes in movement, vision, speech, or thinking.

Glioma-Polyposis Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Turcot Syndrome*.

Gliomatosis Cerebri

A diffuse infiltrative growth pattern of glioma involving multiple brain regions, rather than a separate tumor type in current classifications; it may cause progressive cognitive, motor, or seizure-related symptoms.

Gliosarcoma

A rare aggressive brain cancer containing both glial and connective-tissue-like tumor features. Symptoms depend on location and may include headache, seizures, weakness, or cognitive changes; tissue examination identifies the tumor type.

Gliosis

A reactive increase in glial cells after injury, infection, ischemia, or other damage to the central nervous system.

Glipizide

Glipizide is a short-acting sulfonylurea that lowers blood glucose by stimulating insulin secretion from functioning pancreatic beta cells; hypoglycaemia is the principal adverse effect.

Glisson's Capsule

A thin layer of connective tissue surrounding the liver and extending between its sections. It contains nerves and blood vessels and can cause pain when the liver becomes swollen or inflamed.

Global Aphasia

A severe language disorder caused by extensive damage to the dominant cerebral hemisphere, impairing speech production, comprehension, reading, and writing.

Global Developmental Delay

Noticeably delayed development in at least two areas, such as movement, speech, learning, social skills, or daily activities, in a child younger than five years. Causes vary and may include genetic, neurologic, hearing, vision, or environmental factors; assessment guides support and further testing.

Alternate Names:
GDD

Global Health

The study and practice of improving health across countries and populations. It includes problems that cross borders, such as outbreaks, unequal access to care, pollution, climate change, malnutrition, and differences in life expectancy.

Global Longitudinal Strain

An echocardiogram measurement showing how much the heart muscle shortens lengthwise as it contracts. It can detect early weakening of the left ventricle before the usual pumping measurement changes and is interpreted with the complete heart scan and clinical findings.

Alternate Names:
GLS; 2D Speckle-Tracking GLS; Left Ventricular Longitudinal Strain

Globe Rupture

A full-thickness break in the wall of the eye caused by blunt trauma. It can distort the eye and allow internal tissues to prolapse, with severe vision loss or loss of the eye.

Globin

A protein that joins with heme to form hemoglobin and related oxygen-carrying molecules. Different globin chains help determine the type of hemoglobin made at different stages of life.

Globoid Cell Leukoencephalopathy

Alternate name; see *Krabbe Disease*.

Globozoospermia

A rare sperm disorder in which sperm heads are round and lack a normal acrosome, causing impaired fertilization and male infertility.

Globulin

A group of blood proteins that includes antibodies and proteins involved in transport, inflammation, and clotting. Blood tests may divide globulins into several groups; an abnormal level can occur with infection, immune disease, liver disease, kidney disease, or some cancers.

Globus

Alternate name; see *Globus Sensation*.

Globus Pharyngeus

Alternate name; see *Globus Sensation*.

Globus Hystericus

A sensation of a lump or tightness in the throat without a structural obstruction, now called globus sensation; reflux, muscle tension, and anxiety may contribute.

Globus Pallidus

The globus pallidus is a group of deep brain structures involved in regulating movement as part of the basal ganglia.

Globus Sensation

A persistent or intermittent lump-like feeling in the throat without a structural blockage or difficulty swallowing. It is often noticed between meals and may be associated with reflux, muscle tension, or stress.

Glomangiomyoma

A benign glomus tumor showing both vascular and smooth-muscle differentiation, usually presenting as a small painful subcutaneous nodule.

Glomangiosarcoma

A rare cancerous glomus tumor with abnormal cells and invasive growth. It may occur in the skin or deeper soft tissue.

Glomerular Basement Membrane

A thin supporting layer in the kidney's filtering units. It helps keep blood cells and most proteins in the bloodstream while water and small waste products pass into the urine.

Glomerular Capsule

A cup-shaped structure around a tiny group of blood vessels in the kidney. It collects the fluid filtered from blood and passes it into a kidney tubule, where useful water and substances are reclaimed and waste

is removed.

Glomerular Diseases

A diverse group of kidney disorders that injure the glomeruli, the microscopic filters that remove waste from blood. Damage may cause blood or excess protein in urine, high blood pressure, swelling, or reduced kidney function. Causes include immune, genetic, metabolic, infectious, and systemic diseases; the clinical pattern and course vary with the specific disorder.

Alternate Names:
Glomerular Disease

Glomerular Filtrate

The watery fluid filtered from blood into the kidney tubules by a glomerulus, a small group of kidney blood vessels. It normally contains water and small dissolved substances but very little protein or no blood cells.

Glomerular Filtration

The first step in urine formation, in which pressure moves water and small dissolved substances from blood through kidney filters into the tubules. Blood cells and most proteins normally remain in the bloodstream.

Glomerular Filtration Rate

The volume of plasma filtered by the glomeruli of both kidneys per unit of time, usually indexed to a standard body-surface area. GFR can be measured directly; routine clinical results generally report estimated GFR (eGFR), calculated from serum creatinine or cystatin C. A persistently reduced eGFR can indicate chronic kidney disease when interpreted with other findings.

Glomerular Hyperfiltration

Filtration by the kidney glomeruli above the expected level. It can occur with diabetes, obesity, pregnancy, or loss of functioning kidney tissue. No single cutoff defines it across all people, and the finding alone does not diagnose kidney disease.

Glomeruli

Microscopic clusters of capillaries in the kidneys where blood filtration begins. Each glomerulus is surrounded by a capsule that collects filtered fluid and passes it into a kidney tubule.

Alternate Names:
Renal Glomeruli; Malpighian Corpuscles

Glomerulomegaly

Abnormal enlargement of kidney glomeruli, seen with diabetes, obesity-related hyperfiltration, congenital syndromes, or other causes of glomerular stress.

Glomerulonephritis

An inflammation of the glomeruli, the microscopic filtering units inside the kidneys that clean waste and excess fluid from the blood. It can develop suddenly (acute) following an infection such as strep throat, or gradually over many months (chronic) due to autoimmune diseases or high blood pressure. When these filters become inflamed and damaged, red blood cells and protein leak into the urine, which can cause tea-colored urine, swelling (edema) in the face and legs, and high blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
GN; Glomerular Nephritis

Glomerulonephritis Acute

Sudden inflammation of the kidney glomeruli that can cause blood or protein in urine, edema, hypertension, and reduced kidney function.

Glomerulopathy

Any disease affecting the kidney's filtering units. It may cause blood or protein in urine, swelling, high blood pressure, reduced filtration, or kidney failure and may result from diabetes, infection, immune disease, inherited disorders, or other injury.

Glomerulosclerosis

Scarring and hardening of the kidney's filtering units. It can reduce filtration and cause protein in urine, swelling, high blood pressure, or kidney failure; causes include diabetes, inflammation, genetic disease, and other injury.

Glomerulus

A tuft of tiny blood vessels inside a kidney capsule where water and small dissolved substances are filtered from blood to begin urine formation. Damage can allow blood or excess protein into urine and reduce kidney function.

Glomus Jugulare Tumor

A usually slow-growing paraganglioma arising at the jugular foramen of the temporal bone. It may cause pulsatile tinnitus, hearing loss, dizziness, or lower cranial nerve problems; rarely, it secretes catecholamines. Paragangliomas have variable metastatic potential.

Alternate Names:
Jugular Paraganglioma; Tympanojugular Glomus

Glomus Tumor

A usually harmless growth arising from cells that help control blood flow and temperature, most often beneath a fingernail or in a finger. It typically causes severe pinpoint pain and sensitivity to cold or pressure.

Glomus Tumors

Plural form; see *Glomus Tumor*.

Glomus Tympanicum

Alternate name; see *Glomus Tympanicum Tumor*.

Glomus Tympanicum Tumor

A usually slow-growing paraganglioma arising in the middle ear. It may cause pulsatile tinnitus, hearing loss, or a reddish mass behind the eardrum; some tumors secrete catecholamines or affect nearby nerves.

Alternate Names:
Middle Ear Paraganglioma; Tympanic Glomus

Glossal

Relating to the tongue, the muscular organ used for chewing, swallowing, tasting, and speaking.

Glossalgia

Pain or burning of the tongue, with causes including trauma, infection, nutritional deficiency, neuropathy, medication, or burning-mouth syndrome.

Glossectomy

Surgical removal of all or part of the tongue, performed for malignancies, severe trauma, or an unusually large tongue. Procedures range from partial to total removal. Speech and swallowing rehabilitation may follow.

Glossinidae

The family of flies belonging to the genus Glossina, commonly known as tsetse flies. These insects are vectors of trypanosomes that cause African trypanosomiasis (sleeping sickness) in humans and nagana in animals.

Alternate Names:
Tsetse Flies; Glossina Vectors

Glossitis

Inflammation of the tongue that can cause pain, swelling, or changes in how it looks. Causes include low iron, vitamin B12, or folate; infections; allergies; and diseases in which the immune system attacks the body.

Glossitis Areata Migrans

Alternate name; see *Geographic Tongue*.

Glossodynia

Persistent burning, soreness, or tingling in the tongue, lips, palate, or other mouth tissues, often without visible changes. It may occur with dry mouth, altered taste, nutritional deficiency, medicines, nerve problems, or other illness.

Glossopharyngeal Nerve

The ninth cranial nerve, carrying sensation and taste from the back of the tongue and throat, signals from blood-pressure and blood-chemistry sensors, and motor control for one throat muscle. It also stimulates saliva production.

Glossopharyngeal Neuralgia

Recurrent, brief attacks of severe stabbing or

electric-shock-like pain in the throat, tonsillar region, base of the tongue, or ear, caused by irritation of the glossopharyngeal nerve. Swallowing, coughing, or talking may trigger attacks.

Glossoptosis

Backward displacement of the tongue that can narrow the upper airway, particularly in infants with craniofacial disorders.

Glossopyrosis

Alternate name; see *Burning Mouth Syndrome*.

Glottis

The part of the voice box containing the vocal folds and the opening between them. It opens for breathing, closes to protect the airway during swallowing, and vibrates to produce the voice.

GLP-1 Agonists

Alternate name; see *GLP-1 Receptor Agonists*.

GLP-1 Receptor Agonists

Medicines that activate the glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) receptor. They increase insulin release when blood sugar is high, reduce glucagon release, and can slow stomach emptying and increase feelings of fullness. They are used for type 2 diabetes; some are also used for chronic weight management or other conditions. Approved uses vary by medicine. Common side effects include nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, and constipation.

Alternate Names:
Incretin Mimetics

GLS

Alternate name; see *Global Longitudinal Strain*.

Glu

Commonly an abbreviation for glucose in laboratory or clinical notes; in biochemical notation, Glu can also denote the amino acid glutamic acid, so context matters.

Glucagon

A hormone made by pancreatic alpha cells that raises blood glucose when it falls too low. It prompts the liver to release stored glucose and can be given for severe hypoglycemia.

Glucagon Blood Test

Laboratory measurement of glucagon levels in the blood, used to evaluate suspected glucagonoma, hypoglycemia, or other pancreatic endocrine disorders. Levels are affected by fasting, meals, and medications.

Alternate Names:
Serum Glucagon Level; Plasma Glucagon Assay

Glucagon-like Peptide-1

A hormone released mainly by the intestine after eating. It helps regulate blood glucose by enhancing glucose-dependent insulin secretion, reducing glucagon release, slowing stomach emptying, and influencing appetite.

Glucagonoma

A rare pancreatic neuroendocrine tumor that secretes excess glucagon, causing diabetes mellitus (mild, new onset), dermatitis (necrolytic migratory erythema, characteristic painful, erythematous, blistering rash on groin, perineum, extremities), diarrhea, and deep vein thrombosis.

Glucagon Signaling

The chain of cell signals started when glucagon binds its receptor. These signals increase cyclic AMP and activate proteins that help the liver release glucose and the body maintain energy balance.

Glucan

A complex carbohydrate made of many linked glucose molecules. Different glucans occur in plants, fungi, bacteria, and foods and may act as dietary fiber or interact with the immune system.

Glucarpidase

An enzyme that rapidly breaks down methotrexate in the bloodstream and is used for toxic methotrex-

ate concentrations when renal clearance is inadequate.

Glucocerebrosidase Deficiency

Gaucher Disease: an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase, leading to lipid accumulation in cells and possible enlargement of the spleen and liver, anemia, bone disease, or neurologic disease.

Alternate Names:
Gaucher Disease; Acid Beta-Glucosidase Deficiency

Glucocorticoid

A class of steroid hormones synthesized within the zona fasciculata of the adrenal cortex under the regulatory control of adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH), or their synthetic pharmacological analogues (e.g., prednisone, dexamethasone, hydrocortisone). The primary endogenous human glucocorticoid is cortisol (hydrocortisone). Lipophilic in structure, glucocorticoids cross cell membranes and bind intracellular glucocorticoid receptors (GRs), translocating to the nucleus where they exert both genomic transactivation (inducing transcription of anti-inflammatory proteins such as lipocortin-1/annexin A1 and gluconeogenic enzymes) and transrepression (directly interfering with pro-inflammatory transcription factors NF-κB and AP-1 to potently suppress production of cytokines, chemokines, and prostaglandins). Physiologically essential for intermediary metabolism (stimulating hepatic gluconeogenesis and lipolysis while inhibiting peripheral glucose uptake), maintenance of vascular responsiveness to catecholamines, and adaptation to systemic stress. Exogenous glucocorticoids serve as mainstay therapies for inflammatory, allergic, autoimmune, and lymphoid neoplastic disorders; prolonged systemic administration induces severe iatrogenic adverse effects, including hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal (HPA) axis suppression, iatrogenic Cushing syndrome, secondary osteoporosis, hyperglycemia, central adiposity, cutaneous atrophy, and heightened susceptibility to opportunistic infections.

Alternate Names:
Glucocorticoids; Glucocorticosteroid

Glucocorticoid-Induced Osteoporosis

Bone loss and increased fracture risk caused or accelerated by prolonged or high-dose glucocorticoid treatment; risk depends on dose, duration, baseline bone health, and other factors.

Glucocorticoid Remediable Aldosteronism

Alternate spelling; see *Glucocorticoid-Remediable Aldosteronism*.

Glucocorticoid-Remediable Aldosteronism

An inherited form of high blood pressure in which the adrenal glands make too much aldosterone, a hormone that controls salt and fluid balance. It often begins early in life.

Alternate Names:
GRA; Familial Hyperaldosteronism Type I

Glucocorticoid Replacement Therapy

Treatment of adrenal insufficiency with a glucocorticoid medicine to replace the cortisol the body lacks. Doses may vary with symptoms, illness, and physical stress.

Glucocorticoids

Plural form; see *Glucocorticoid*.

Glucocorticoid-Sparing Therapy

Use of a non-glucocorticoid treatment strategy to control inflammation while reducing cumulative corticosteroid exposure. It aims to limit osteoporosis, infection, diabetes, hypertension, adrenal suppression, and other glucocorticoid complications.

Glucometer

A handheld device that measures blood glucose, usually from a small capillary-blood sample obtained by finger prick.

Gluconates

Salts or esters of gluconic acid used in some medicines and supplements. Examples include calcium gluconate and ferrous gluconate; their effects,

dosing, and risks depend on the specific compound.

Gluconeogenesis

A metabolic pathway that generates glucose from non-carbohydrate precursors such as lactate, glycerol, and glucogenic amino acids. It occurs mainly in the liver and, to a variable extent, in the kidneys and other tissues.

Glucosamine

A naturally occurring compound used in cartilage formation and sometimes taken as a supplement for joint symptoms.

Glucosamine and Chondroitin

Dietary supplements marketed for joint symptoms and cartilage support. Evidence of benefit varies, and products may interact with medicines or affect blood sugar or bleeding risk.

Glucose

A simple sugar (monosaccharide) and a major source of energy for cells. It enters the blood after carbohydrates are digested. The liver can also release glucose from stored glycogen or make it from other substances. Insulin and other hormones help regulate blood glucose levels.

Glucose-6-Phosphatase

An enzyme in the liver and kidneys that releases glucose from glucose-6-phosphate. Inherited deficiency causes glycogen-storage disease type I, which can produce low blood glucose, enlarged liver, and metabolic problems.

Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase Deficiency

The most common red blood cell enzymopathy in humans, affecting over 400 million people worldwide, transmitted as an X-linked recessive genetic disorder caused by mutations in the *G6PD* gene on chromosome Xq28. The G6PD enzyme catalyzes the rate-limiting first step of the hexose monophosphate (pentose phosphate) shunt, converting glucose-6-phosphate to 6-phosphoglucono-δ-lactone and generating NADPH. Because erythrocytes lack mitochondria and alternative NADPH-generating pathways, they depend entirely on G6PD-derived NADPH to reduce oxidized glutathione back to reduced glutathione (GSH), the primary cellular antioxidant defense that detoxifies reactive oxygen species and hydrogen peroxide. Loss of functional G6PD activity renders erythrocytes exquisitely susceptible to acute oxidative damage. When exposed to external oxidative stressors—specifically infections (the most common trigger), ingestion of fava beans (favism, containing toxic pyrimidine glucosides vicine and convicine), or medications (dapsone, primaquine, rasburicase, nitrofurantoin, phenazopyridine, methylene blue)—sulfhydryl groups on hemoglobin chains oxidize, causing hemoglobin denaturation and precipitation into insoluble intracellular aggregates called Heinz bodies. Splenic red pulp macrophages pluck these inclusions from erythrocytes, creating characteristic "bite cells" (degmacytes) and "blister cells," culminating in acute intravascular and extravascular episodic hemolytic anemia. Clinically presents 2 to 4 days post-exposure with sudden fatigue, pallor, dark cola-colored urine (hemoglobinuria), scleral icterus, and back/abdominal pain. Confirmatory testing requires quantitative erythrocyte G6PD spectrophotometric enzymatic assays, which may yield false-negative normal results during acute hemolytic episodes because mature G6PD-deficient red cells have hemolyzed, leaving a reticulocyte-rich population with higher enzyme levels; re-testing 2 to 3 months post-crisis is mandatory. Management focuses on avoidance of oxidative triggers and supportive transfusions during severe hemolytic crises.

Alternate Names:
G6PD Deficiency; Favism

Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase Test

Laboratory test that measures G6PD enzyme activity in red blood cells to diagnose G6PD deficiency. The result can identify risk of hemolytic anemia from oxidant medicines such as primaquine or dapsone.

Alternate Names:
G6PD Assay; Erythrocyte Enzyme Screen

Glucose Challenge Test

A screening test for gestational diabetes mellitus, commonly using a nonfasting 50-g glucose drink followed by a one-hour plasma-glucose measurement. An abnormal screening result is followed by a diagnostic oral glucose tolerance test; the threshold depends on the protocol used.

Alternate Names:
GCT; One-Hour Glucose Challenge; O'Sullivan Screening Test

Glucose Intolerance

Impaired handling of glucose resulting in blood-glucose concentrations above normal but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes in a defined testing context. It often reflects insulin resistance or inadequate insulin secretion and is associated with increased risk of type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease.

Glucose Management Indicator

An estimate of the hemoglobin A1c value calculated from average continuous-glucose-monitoring readings. It helps summarize recent glucose exposure but is not the same as a laboratory A1c and may differ from it.

Glucose Screening Tests During Pregnancy

Laboratory tests to detect gestational diabetes mellitus, including the oral glucose tolerance test and glucose challenge test. They are usually performed between 24 and 28 weeks of gestation; abnormal results are followed by additional testing or management.

Alternate Names:
Gestational Diabetes Screening; Maternal Glucose Screen

Glucose Sensor

A small sensor placed under the skin that measures glucose in the fluid between cells. Used in continuous glucose monitoring, it sends repeated readings to a receiver or compatible device and can show trends and alerts.

Glucose Test

A test that measures glucose in a blood, urine, or other sample. Blood tests used for diabetes include fasting plasma glucose, random plasma glucose, and the oral glucose tolerance test; the method and timing determine how a result is interpreted.

Glucose Tolerance Test

A test of how the body handles a measured glucose drink. Blood samples are taken before and at set times afterward to help diagnose diabetes or gestational diabetes; thresholds depend on the protocol.

Alternate Names:
Oral Glucose Tolerance Test (OGTT)

Glucose Transport

Movement of glucose across cell membranes through specialized transport proteins. Insulin increases glucose entry into muscle and fat cells, while other transporters allow glucose to enter the brain, liver, kidneys, and intestines.

Glucose Transporter

A membrane protein that moves glucose across a cell membrane; transporter defects or altered regulation can affect glucose metabolism.

Glucose Urine Test

A urine test that detects glucose, usually with a reagent strip. Glucose can appear when blood levels exceed the kidney's reabsorption capacity, but it may also occur with pregnancy, some medicines, or kidney-tubule disorders; it is not a substitute for blood-glucose testing.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Glucose; Glycosuria Screen

Glucosuria

Alternate spelling; see *Glycosuria*.

Glucosylceramidase

A lysosomal enzyme that breaks down glucosylceramide, a fat-containing cell substance. Inherited deficiency causes Gaucher disease, allowing fatty

material to accumulate in the spleen, liver, bone marrow, bones, or nervous system.

Glucosyl Ceramide Lipidosis

Alternate name; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Glucuronate

The anion or salt of glucuronic acid, a sugar-acid component of connective-tissue substances and a molecule used in hepatic conjugation reactions.

Glucuronic Acid

A sugar acid used by the liver to conjugate bilirubin, drugs, hormones, and toxins, increasing their water solubility for excretion.

Glucuronide

A compound formed when glucuronic acid is conjugated to a drug, hormone, bilirubin, or other molecule, usually increasing water solubility and facilitating excretion.

Glucuronyl Transferase

An enzyme that attaches glucuronic acid to bilirubin, medicines, hormones, and other substances, usually making them easier to excrete. Reduced activity of specific UDP-glucuronosyltransferase enzymes contributes to Gilbert syndrome or Crigler–Najjar syndrome.

Alternate Names:
UDP-Glucuronosyltransferase; UGT Enzyme

Glue Ear

Persistent fluid in the middle ear without acute infection, often causing conductive hearing loss and a feeling of blockage. It is common in children.

Alternate Names:
Secretory Otitis Media; Otitis Media with Effusion (OME)

GLUT4 Transporter

The major insulin- and exercise-regulated glucose transporter isoform expressed primarily in striated muscle (skeletal and cardiac) and adipose tissue, which translocates from intracellular vesicles to the plasma membrane upon insulin stimulation to facilitate cellular glucose uptake.

Glutamate

The main excitatory chemical messenger in the brain and spinal cord. It helps nerve cells communicate, learn, and form memories; excessive glutamate activity can contribute to nerve-cell injury.

Glutamate Decarboxylase

Glutamate decarboxylase is an enzyme that converts glutamate into the neurotransmitter GABA; antibodies against it are associated with some autoimmune disorders.

Glutamate Receptor

A neuronal receptor activated by glutamate, the major excitatory neurotransmitter, including NMDA, AMPA, kainate, and metabotropic receptor classes.

Glutamic Acid

An amino acid that acts as a metabolic intermediate and neurotransmitter precursor; its charged form, glutamate, mediates most fast excitatory signaling in the brain.

Glutamic Acid Decarboxylase

An enzyme that converts glutamate to GABA; antibodies to it can occur in type 1 diabetes.

Alternate Names:
GAD; Glutamate Decarboxylase

Glutamine

An amino acid used to build proteins, transport nitrogen, and provide energy for some cells, especially cells in the intestine and immune system. The body usually makes enough, but needs may change during severe illness.

Glutaral

Glutaral is a chemical disinfectant and tissue fixative that can irritate the skin, eyes, and airways.

Glutaric Acidemia Type 1

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot

break down certain amino acids, allowing harmful substances to build up. Babies may have a large head and can develop sudden brain injury, abnormal movements, or stiffness during illness; newborn screening and dietary treatment can reduce harm.

Alternate Names:
Glutaric Aciduria Type 1 (GA-1); Glutaryl-CoA Dehydrogenase Deficiency

Glutaric Aciduria

An inherited metabolic disorder in which the body cannot properly break down certain amino acids. Type I can cause brain injury, movement problems, and enlarged head size.

Glutathione

A small molecule made from glutamate, cysteine, and glycine that helps protect cells from oxidative damage. It also participates in processing drugs and other reactive chemicals, including a toxic metabolite of acetaminophen.

Glutathione Disulfide

The oxidized form of glutathione, produced after glutathione neutralizes reactive oxygen compounds. Cells normally convert it back to active glutathione to maintain antioxidant protection.

Glutathione Peroxidase

A family of enzymes that uses glutathione to break down hydrogen peroxide and other peroxides, helping protect cells from oxidative damage. Several forms contain selenium.

Alternate Names:
GPx

Glutathione Synthetase Deficiency

An inherited disorder caused by deficient glutathione synthetase, the enzyme needed to make glutathione. Severity ranges from hemolytic anemia and excess 5-oxoproline to metabolic acidosis, neurologic impairment, recurrent infection, or seizures.

Glutathione Transferase

A family of enzymes that attaches glutathione to selected medicines, toxins, and products of cell metabolism. This usually makes them less reactive and easier for the body to process or remove.

Gluteal

Relating to the buttock or the gluteal muscles, which extend and rotate the hip and help stabilize the pelvis.

Gluteal Gait

An abnormal walking gait caused by weakness or paralysis of the hip abductor muscles (gluteus medius and minimus) innervated by the superior gluteal nerve, manifested by a downward pelvic tilt toward the unsupported swing leg during single-leg stance, compensated by leaning the trunk toward the affected stance side.

Alternate Names:
Trendelenburg Gait; Gluteus Medius Gait

Gluteal Injury

Damage to the muscles, tendons, nerves, or soft tissues of the buttock caused by trauma, overuse, injection, or falls. Pain, bruising, weakness, difficulty walking, severe swelling, numbness, inability to bear weight, or bowel or bladder changes may occur.

Gluteal Muscle

One of the large muscles of the buttock, especially the gluteus maximus, medius, or minimus. These muscles extend, rotate, and move the hip and help stabilize the pelvis during standing and walking.

Gluteal Tendinopathy

Tendon degeneration, microtrauma, and tearing affecting the insertion of the gluteus medius or gluteus minimus tendons onto the greater trochanter of the femur, representing the predominant cause of greater trochanteric pain syndrome in middle-aged and older adults.

Gluteal Muscle Strain

An overstretch or small tear in one of the buttock muscles. It can cause pain, tenderness, or weakness in the buttock, often after a sudden movement or

intense exercise.

Gluten

A complex of storage proteins (prolamins and glutelins) found in wheat (gliadin), barley (hordein), and rye (secalin). Gluten provides elasticity to dough. In susceptible individuals, gluten triggers an autoimmune response (celiac disease) or non-autoimmune sensitivity (non-celiac gluten sensitivity, NCGS).

Gluten Enteropathy

Celiac disease, an immune reaction to gluten that damages the small intestine and can cause diarrhea, weight loss, anemia, fatigue, or poor nutrient absorption.

Alternate Names:
Celiac Disease; Celiac Sprue

Gluten-Free Diet

A diet that avoids wheat, barley, rye, and foods contaminated with them. It is essential for celiac disease and may help selected people with non-celiac gluten sensitivity; poorly planned diets can lack fiber or nutrients.

Gluten Intolerance

An informal, nonspecific label for symptoms associated with eating foods containing gluten or wheat. It may refer to celiac disease, wheat allergy, or non-celiac gluten or wheat sensitivity, which are distinct conditions with different mechanisms and diagnostic criteria. The term alone does not identify which condition is present.

Gluten-Sensitive Enteropathy

Alternate name; see *Celiac Disease*.

Gluten Sensitivity

A commonly used name for non-celiac gluten/wheat sensitivity: symptoms after eating wheat- or gluten-containing foods in people without celiac disease or wheat allergy. The food trigger may not be gluten itself, and no single test confirms the condition.

Gluteus

Relating to the buttock muscles. The gluteus maximus, medius, and minimus move and stabilize the hip and pelvis during standing, walking, climbing, and other movements.

Gluteus Maximus Muscle

The largest, most superficial buttock muscle. It extends and rotates the hip and helps raise the body from a seated position, climb stairs, and stand upright; it is supplied by the inferior gluteal nerve.

Gluteus Medius Muscle

Thick fan-shaped muscle between maximus and minimus, from external ilium to the greater trochanter. Innervated by superior gluteal nerve (L4-S1). Primary hip abductor essential for pelvic stability during single-leg stance. Superior gluteal nerve injury causes Trendelenburg sign with contralateral pelvic drop.

Gluteus Minimus Muscle

The smallest and deepest gluteal muscle, extending from the outer ilium to the greater trochanter. It abducts and medially rotates the hip and helps stabilize the pelvis during walking.

Glyburide

An oral sulfonylurea that stimulates pancreatic insulin release for type 2 diabetes; prolonged or severe hypoglycemia is an important risk.

Glycaemia

British spelling; see *Glycemia*.

Glycated Hemoglobin

Hemoglobin with glucose attached through a nonenzymatic chemical reaction. Hemoglobin A1c is a specific glycated form measured in a blood test used to estimate average blood glucose over the preceding two to three months; results can be affected by abnormal red-cell survival.

Alternate Names:
Glycohemoglobin; Glycosylated Hemoglobin (older term)

Glycated Hemoglobin Test

A blood test (HbA1c) measuring the percentage of hemoglobin bound to glucose, providing an average index of blood sugar control over the preceding 2 to 3 months; see *Glycated Hemoglobin*.

Glycation

A chemical process in which sugar attaches to proteins, fats, or genetic material without the usual enzyme control. Excess glycation during prolonged high blood glucose can damage blood vessels, nerves, kidneys, eyes, and other tissues.

Glycemia

The amount of glucose in the blood. It is affected by food, activity, illness, the liver, and hormones such as insulin and glucagon. Too little is hypoglycemia; too much is hyperglycemia.

Glycemic Control

The level and pattern of blood-glucose management over time. It includes glucose values, symptoms, and the effects of food, activity, illness, medicines, pregnancy, and other circumstances.

Glycemic Index

A measure of how much a food containing available carbohydrate raises blood glucose compared with a reference food, when equal amounts of carbohydrate are tested. It does not represent the effect of a usual serving; that is better reflected by glycemic load.

Alternate Names:
GI

Glycemic Load

A measure that combines a food's glycemic index with the amount of available carbohydrate in a serving to estimate its effect on blood glucose.

Glyceraldehyde

A small sugar with three carbon atoms that appears as the body breaks down glucose and other carbohydrates. It is quickly changed into other substances during the steps that release energy from food.

Glyceride

A glyceride is a compound formed when glycerol is linked to one or more fatty acids, including many dietary fats.

Glycerin

A colorless, odorless, sweet-tasting liquid also known as glycerol. It attracts water, dissolves some substances, and is used in medicines, skin products, foods, and selected treatments.

Glycerol

A colorless, sweet-tasting alcohol that forms part of fats. It is used in medicines, foods, and skin products and can draw water into the bowel when used in some laxatives.

Alternate Names:
Glycerine; Trihydroxypropane

Glycerol Kinase

Glycerol kinase is an enzyme that adds phosphate to glycerol, allowing it to enter pathways for energy production and fat metabolism.

Glycerophosphates

Compounds containing glycerol and phosphate that help build cell membranes and participate in energy metabolism, chemical signaling, and other cellular processes.

Glycerophospholipids

The major membrane phospholipids built from glycerol, fatty acids, phosphate, and a polar head group, including phosphatidylcholine and phosphatidylethanolamine.

Glycerylphosphorylcholine

A choline-containing substance formed when certain membrane fats are broken down. It occurs in body fluids and cells and participates in membrane metabolism and the supply of choline.

Glyceryl Trinitrate

A nitrate medicine, also called nitroglycerin, that releases nitric oxide and relaxes blood vessels. It can

relieve or prevent angina, but may cause headache, dizziness, or low blood pressure and can interact dangerously with phosphodiesterase-5 inhibitors.

Glycine

A small amino acid used to make proteins and heme. It also acts as an inhibitory chemical messenger, especially in the spinal cord and brainstem, helping regulate movement and reflexes.

Glycine Receptor

A ligand-gated chloride channel activated by glycine that mediates inhibitory neurotransmission, especially in the spinal cord and brainstem.

Glycocalyx

A sugar-rich coating on the outside of many cells, including cells lining blood vessels. It helps protect surfaces, control passage of substances, support cell attachment, and influence inflammation and clotting.

Glycogen

The body's stored form of glucose. It is kept mainly in the liver, which releases it between meals, and in muscles, which use it during activity.

Glycogenesis

The process of converting glucose into glycogen for storage, mainly in the liver and muscles. It occurs after eating, when blood glucose and insulin levels rise.

Glycogenolysis

The breakdown of stored glycogen. The liver uses it to release glucose into the blood between meals, while muscles use their glycogen locally for energy during exercise.

Glycogen Storage Disease

A group of rare, inherited metabolic disorders in which the body lacks one of the specialized enzymes needed to properly make, store, or break down glycogen (the body's stored form of glucose). Depending on which specific enzyme is missing, glycogen accumulates abnormally in the liver, muscles, or heart, which can cause episodes of dangerously low blood sugar (hypoglycemia), an enlarged liver, muscle cramps, and exercise weakness.

Alternate Names:
Glycogen Storage Diseases; GSD; Glycogenosis

Glycogen Storage Diseases

Plural form; see *Glycogen Storage Disease*.

Glycogen Storage Disease Type 0 (GSD-0)

An inherited glycogen-synthase deficiency in which the liver or muscles cannot store normal amounts of glycogen. Liver disease may cause fasting ketotic hypoglycemia and post-meal hyperglycemia, while muscle disease may cause exercise intolerance, weakness, or cardiomyopathy.

Glycohemoglobin

Alternate name; see *Glycated Hemoglobin*.

Glycolipid

A lipid containing a carbohydrate group that contributes to cell membranes, recognition, signaling, and myelin structure.

Glycolysis

A series of reactions in the cytosol that breaks one glucose molecule into two pyruvate molecules. It produces ATP and other molecules used in further energy production and can proceed when oxygen is limited.

Glycopeptide

A molecule made of a short protein chain with one or more attached sugar groups. Glycopeptides occur in cell-surface proteins, antibodies, and some medicines, and the attached sugars can affect structure and function.

Glycophorin

A sugar-coated protein in the red-blood-cell membrane that helps maintain the cell surface and carries markers used to distinguish blood-cell types.

Glycoprotein

A protein with covalently attached carbohydrate chains, important in receptors, antibodies, enzymes, mucus, cell adhesion, and extracellular matrix.

Glycopyrrolate

Glycopyrrolate is an anticholinergic medicine used to reduce secretions and, in some inhaled forms, to help control chronic obstructive lung disease; it may cause dry mouth, constipation, or urinary retention.

Glycosaminoglycan

A long, unbranched carbohydrate chain found in the extracellular matrix and connective tissues. Abnormal breakdown or accumulation of GAGs occurs in mucopolysaccharidoses.

Glycosaminoglycans

Plural form; see *Glycosaminoglycan*.

Glycoside

A compound in which a sugar is chemically linked to another molecule. Glycosides occur in plants, foods, and medicines; their effects depend on the attached molecule and how the body breaks the bond.

Glycosphingolipid

A membrane lipid containing ceramide and one or more sugars, involved in cell recognition, signaling, and nervous-system structure.

Glycosuria

The presence of glucose in the urine. It can occur when blood glucose exceeds the kidney's reabsorption capacity, or when kidney tubules do not reabsorb glucose normally; pregnancy and some medicines can also contribute.

Glycosylated Hemoglobin

Alternate name; see *Glycated Hemoglobin*.

Glycosylation

Attachment of sugar chains to proteins or fats inside cells. This process helps determine their shape, stability, location, and activity; abnormal glycosylation can contribute to inherited disease, cancer, and immune disorders.

Glycosylphosphatidylinositol

A lipid-and-sugar anchor that attaches certain proteins to the outer surface of a cell membrane. Defects in making or attaching this anchor can cause rare blood, nerve, or developmental disorders.

Glycosyltransferase

Glycosyltransferase is an enzyme that transfers a sugar to a protein, lipid, or other molecule during glycan synthesis.

Glycyrrhetinic Acid

An active metabolite of licorice glycosides that inhibits 11-beta-hydroxysteroid dehydrogenase; excess exposure can cause hypertension, low potassium, and fluid retention.

Glycyrrhizic Acid

The major saponin in licorice root that is converted to glycyrrhetinic acid and can produce mineralocorticoid-like toxicity when consumed excessively.

Glyphosate

A broad-spectrum herbicide that inhibits plant EPSP synthase; concentrated exposure can irritate tissues and cause systemic poisoning, especially after ingestion.

Gm

Abbreviation; see *Gram*.

GN

Abbreviation; see *Glomerulonephritis*.

Gnathic

Relating to the jaw, especially the upper jaw or lower jaw and their development, structure, or position.

Gnathion

The lowest midline point on the outer surface of the lower jaw. It is used as a landmark in dental,

orthodontic, facial, and skull measurements.

Gnathitis

Inflammation of the jaw or jaw tissues. It may cause pain, swelling, tenderness, difficulty opening the mouth, or chewing problems and can result from infection, injury, or inflammatory disease.

Gnathoplasty

Plastic or reconstructive surgery to reshape or repair the jaw. It may improve function, facial balance, or a structural defect; risks include infection, nerve injury, altered bite, and recurrence.

Gnathostoma

A group of roundworms that can infect people who eat raw or undercooked freshwater fish, frogs, or other carriers. Larvae may migrate through skin, organs, or the nervous system and cause swelling, pain, or serious neurologic disease.

Gnathostoma Spinigerum

A roundworm that can cause gnathostomiasis after people eat raw or undercooked freshwater animals. Migrating larvae may produce recurring painful skin swellings and, rarely, eye or brain disease.

Gnathostomiasis

A parasitic infection caused by Gnathostoma larvae acquired from undercooked freshwater fish or other hosts, producing migratory skin swellings or deeper neurologic or ocular disease.

Gnawing Pain

A dull, persistent pain often described as an ache or a feeling that something is eating away at the body. It can arise from muscles, nerves, internal organs, or inflammation. Its location, duration, triggers, and accompanying symptoms help identify the cause.

GNE Myopathy

A rare inherited muscle disease that usually begins in early adulthood and slowly weakens the muscles of the lower legs, causing foot drop, then the hands and arms. The thigh muscles are often spared until late disease. There is no cure, but rehabilitation helps maintain function.

Alternate Names:
Nonaka Myopathy; Distal Myopathy with Rimmed Vacuoles (DMRV); Hereditary Inclusion Body Myopathy (HIBM)

GnRH

Gonadotropin-releasing hormone, a hormone from the brain that signals the pituitary gland to release hormones controlling ovulation, sperm production, and sex-hormone production.

Alternate Names:
Gonadotropin-Releasing Hormone

GnRH Agonist

A medicine that first increases and then suppresses signals from the pituitary gland to the reproductive organs. It lowers sex-hormone production and is used in selected fertility treatments, endometriosis, fibroids, and hormone-sensitive cancers.

GnRH Antagonist

A medicine that directly blocks the brain-to-pituitary signal controlling reproductive hormones. It lowers these hormones quickly without the temporary hormone rise that can occur when a GnRH agonist is started.

GnRH Antagonists

Plural form; see *GnRH Antagonist*.

Goal Attainment Scaling

A way to measure progress toward personal healthcare goals. The goal is defined in advance with levels ranging from much less than expected to much better than expected, then scored after treatment.

Goal Setting

Choosing clear, realistic outcomes and deciding how and when to work toward them. In healthcare, goals can reflect a person's priorities, include a way to measure progress, and change as needs or circumstances change.

Goals-Of-Care Discussion

A clinical conversation that aligns treatment recommendations with a patient's values, priorities, prognosis, acceptable burdens, and preferred outcomes. It may include decisions about hospitalization, resuscitation, artificial nutrition, and comfort-focused care.

Goblet Cell

A specialized, polarized, simple columnar epithelial cell found interspersed throughout the mucosal lining of the respiratory tract (trachea, bronchi, large bronchioles) and gastrointestinal tract (predominantly the small intestine and large intestine). Named for its goblet-like morphology, it possesses a narrow basal stem containing the nucleus and compressed organelles, and an expanded, distended apical cup packed with membrane-bound mucinogen granules. Secretes high-molecular-weight gel-forming mucin glycoproteins (principally MUC2 in the intestine and MUC5AC/MUC5B in the respiratory tract) via basal merocrine exocytosis and compound exocytosis. Upon hydration at the epithelial surface, mucin swells several hundred-fold to form a protective, viscoelastic, lubricating mucous gel layer that shields underlying mucosal cells from enzymatic degradation, mechanical shearing, pathogenic invasion, and chemical injury. Goblet cell hyperplasia occurs in chronic airway inflammation (asthma, COPD, chronic bronchitis). Ectopic appearance of goblet cells in the distal esophagus defines specialized intestinal metaplasia (Barrett esophagus); malignant transformation of goblet-like cells characterizes aggressive signet-ring cell adenocarcinomas.

Alternate Names:
Goblet Cells

Goblet Cell Adenocarcinoma

A distinctive appendiceal adenocarcinoma composed of goblet-like mucinous cells, formerly called goblet cell carcinoid. It can spread within the peritoneum or to the ovaries and is managed according to grade, stage, and dissemination.

Goblet Cells

Plural form; see *Goblet Cell*.

Goeckerman Regimen

A dermatological therapy used for extensive or recalcitrant plaque psoriasis combining the daily topical application of crude coal tar with exposure to ultraviolet B (UVB) phototherapy.

Alternate Names:
Goeckerman Therapy; Coal Tar and UVB Regimen

Goiter

Enlargement of the thyroid gland, either throughout the gland or as one or more nodules. Thyroid hormone levels may be normal, high, or low. Causes include iodine deficiency, autoimmune thyroid disease, and nodular growth; a goiter does not by itself mean that the thyroid is overactive or cancerous.

Goitre

British spelling; see *Goiter*.

Goitrogenic Foods

Foods or food components that can interfere with thyroid hormone production or iodine use under some conditions; risk depends on intake, preparation, iodine status, and thyroid health.

Goitrous Autoimmune Thyroiditis

Alternate name; see *Hashimoto Thyroiditis*.

Gold

A metal used in selected dental restorations, implants, laboratory applications, and historical medicinal preparations; exposure can cause contact allergy or toxicity depending on the compound and dose.

Gold Alloy

A mixture of gold and other metals used for some dental restorations. It is durable, fits closely, and is usually well tolerated by body tissues, but it costs more and has a distinctive appearance.

Gold Alloys

Plural form; see *Gold Alloy*.

Goldenhar Syndrome

A birth condition, also called oculo-auriculo-vertebral spectrum, in which one side of the face, ear, eye, or spine develops differently. Features may include facial asymmetry, a small or misshapen ear, hearing loss, eyelid or eye-surface growths, and spinal differences.

Golden Hour

An informal term for the early period after serious injury when prompt assessment and treatment may be important. There is no fixed one-hour cutoff that applies to all injuries or emergencies.

Goldmann Tonometry

A slit-lamp examination that estimates intraocular pressure by measuring the force needed to flatten a defined area of the cornea.

Gold Therapy

Treatment with gold-containing medicines, formerly used mainly for rheumatoid arthritis. Its use is now limited because benefit is slow and serious effects can include skin or mouth inflammation, kidney injury, and reduced blood-cell counts.

Golfer Elbow

Alternate spelling; see *Golfer's Elbow*.

Golfer's Elbow

Painful irritation or degeneration of tendons attached to the inner side of the elbow. Repeated gripping or wrist movement can cause tenderness, reduced strength, and pain during lifting or bending.

Golgi Apparatus

A structure inside cells that modifies, sorts, and packages proteins and fats made by the cell, sending them to other parts of the cell or releasing them outside it.

Golgi Cisternae

Flattened membrane-bound sacs that form the Golgi apparatus and modify, sort, and package proteins and lipids for transport within or outside the cell.

Golgi Tendon Organ

A sensory structure where a muscle joins its tendon. It detects tension in the muscle and tendon and helps the nervous system control muscle force and protect against excessive strain.

Gomori's Stain

Gomori's stain is a group of laboratory stains used to highlight structures such as connective tissue, carbohydrates, fungi, or muscle components in tissue samples.

Gomphosis

A fixed joint in which a tooth is held in its socket by a strong ligament.

Gonad

A reproductive organ, usually a testis or ovary, that produces sperm or eggs and sex hormones. Gonads may vary in development or function and influence puberty, fertility, and other body processes.

Gonadal Agenesis

Congenital absence of one or both gonads. It can impair sex-hormone production and fertility and may occur with differences in sex development.

Gonadal Dysgenesis

Incomplete or abnormal development of the ovaries or testes, often resulting from chromosomal abnormalities, gene variants, or disordered sex development. It may cause atypical genital development, delayed or absent puberty, infertility, and abnormal gonadal hormone production.

Gonadal Vein

A vein draining a testis or ovary. The right gonadal vein usually drains directly into the inferior vena cava, while the left usually drains into the left renal vein.

Gonad Disorder

A broad category for diseases that affect the testes or ovaries. Depending on the cause, a disorder may impair sperm or egg production, sex-hormone pro-

duction, or normal gonadal development; the specific disease and affected function should be named when known.

Gonadoblastoma

A rare tumor that develops in an abnormal or incompletely developed ovary or testicle. It may produce sex hormones and has a risk of becoming a malignant germ-cell tumor, especially when a Y-chromosome change is present.

Gonadorelin

Synthetic gonadotropin-releasing hormone that stimulates pituitary release of luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone when given intermittently.

Gonadotrophin

British spelling; see *Gonadotropin*.

Gonadotrophin-Releasing Factors

Alternate spelling and plural form; see *Gonadotropin-Releasing Hormone*.

Gonadotrophins

British spelling and plural form; see *Gonadotropin*.

Gonadotrophs

Pituitary cells that release luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone after stimulation by GnRH, regulating the ovaries, testes, fertility, and sex-hormone production.

Gonadotropin

A member of a family of heterodimeric glycoprotein hormones that act directly on the gonads (ovaries and testes) to stimulate gametogenesis and steroidogenesis. Composed of two non-covalently linked glycosylated polypeptide subunits: a common α-subunit (identical across LH, FSH, hCG, and TSH) and a hormone-specific β-subunit that confers unique receptor binding specificity and biological action. The principal human gonadotropins are: Luteinizing Hormone (LH) and Follicle-Stimulating Hormone (FSH), synthesized and secreted in a pulsatile manner by anterior pituitary gonadotrophs under the hypothalamic stimulation of gonadotropin-releasing hormone (GnRH); and Human Chorionic Gonadotropin (hCG), synthesized by the placental syncytiotrophoblast during pregnancy to maintain the corpus luteum. In females, FSH stimulates ovarian follicular maturation and granulosa cell estrogen synthesis via aromatase induction, while LH stimulates theca cell androgen production, triggers mid-cycle ovulation, and supports corpus luteum progesterone secretion. In males, FSH acts on Sertoli cells in the seminiferous tubules to promote spermatogenesis and synthesize androgen-binding protein, while LH acts on Leydig cells in the interstitial compartment to stimulate testosterone biosynthesis. Clinical applications include recombinant gonadotropins for ovulation induction and assisted reproductive technologies.

Alternate Names:
Gonadotropins; Gonadotrophic Hormone; Gonadotrophin; Gonadotrophins

Gonadotropin Hormone

Redundant form; see *Gonadotropin*.

Gonadotropin-Releasing Hormone

A hormone made in the brain that signals the pituitary gland to release two hormones, FSH and LH. These hormones control the ovaries and testes, including egg development, ovulation, sperm production, and sex-hormone production.

Alternate Names:
GnRH

Gonadotropins

Plural form; see *Gonadotropin*.

Gonads

Plural form; see *Gonad*.

Gondoic Acid

A 20-carbon monounsaturated fatty acid found in some seed oils and incorporated into dietary and tissue lipids.

Goniometer

An instrument measuring joint angles and range of motion, used to assess stiffness, document impairment, and track progress during rehabilitation.

Gonioscopy

An eye examination using a special contact lens to view the angle where the iris meets the cornea. It helps determine whether glaucoma is open-angle or angle-closure and guides treatment.

Gonococcal

Relating to Neisseria gonorrhoeae, the bacterium that causes gonorrhea. Gonococcal infection commonly affects the genitals, rectum, or throat and may spread to joints or blood.

Gonococcal Arthritis

A disseminated infection of joints caused by Neisseria gonorrhoeae, often with fever, migrating joint or tendon pain, skin pustules, and inflammation around tendons.

Gonococcal Pharyngitis

Infection of the throat by Neisseria gonorrhoeae, usually acquired through sexual contact. It may cause sore throat or no symptoms.

Gonococcal Urethritis

Infection and inflammation of the urethra caused by Neisseria gonorrhoeae. It may cause burning urination or discharge, but some people have no symptoms; untreated infection can spread.

Gonococcus

A spherical bacterium of the genus Neisseria. Neisseria gonorrhoeae, the gonococcus, causes the sexually transmitted infection gonorrhea.

Gonorrhea

A sexually transmitted infection caused by the bacterium Neisseria gonorrhoeae. It may cause discharge, painful urination, pelvic or rectal symptoms, or no symptoms. Untreated infection can lead to infertility, joint infection, or infection in a newborn.

Gonorrhoea

Alternate spelling; see *Gonorrhea*.

Goodell Sign

A clinical sign of early pregnancy characterized by marked softening of the uterine cervix (produced by increased pelvic vascularity and edema), identifiable upon digital pelvic bimanual examination around the sixth to eighth week of gestation.

Goodpasture's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Goodpasture Syndrome*.

Goodpasture Syndrome

A rare condition involving bleeding in the lungs and inflammation of the kidney filters. It is often linked to antibodies against tissues in the lungs and kidneys; when these antibodies cause the illness, it is called anti-GBM disease.

Goose Bump

A small raised area around a hair follicle caused by contraction of tiny arrector pili muscles, commonly in response to cold, fear, or strong emotion.

Gooseflesh

Temporary raised bumps around hair follicles caused by contraction of tiny skin muscles, often in response to cold, fear, or strong emotion. It is usually harmless.

Goose-Skin

Goose skin is the temporary raising of hair follicles, usually caused by cold, fear, or strong emotion.

Gorlin's Syndrome

An inherited disorder that increases the risk of multiple basal-cell skin cancers, jaw cysts, and abnormalities of the bones, eyes, and nervous system.

Gorlin Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Gorlin's Syndrome*.

Goserelin

A gonadotropin-releasing hormone agonist that ini-

tially stimulates and then suppresses pituitary gonadotropins; it is used in hormone-sensitive prostate or breast cancer and selected gynecologic conditions.

Gottron Papules

Erythematous to violaceous, often scaly papules or plaques over the extensor surfaces of the finger joints, especially the knuckles. They are a characteristic skin finding of dermatomyositis and may occur without muscle weakness. Similar lesions on the elbows, knees, or ankles are often called Gottron sign.

Alternate Names:
Gottron's Papules

Gottron Sign

Symmetrical, violaceous, macular or papular erythematous patches and scaling located over the extensor aspects of the joints (particularly the elbows, patellae, and medial malleoli), serving as a characteristic cutaneous hallmark of dermatomyositis.

Alternate Names:
Gottron's Sign; Dermatomyositis Extensor Erythema

Gougerot-Carteaud Syndrome

A skin disorder causing brown, slightly raised spots that join into net-like patches, usually on the upper chest, back, or neck of young people.

Gout

A painful form of inflammatory arthritis caused by high levels of uric acid in the blood (hyperuricemia). When excess uric acid cannot be eliminated by the kidneys, it forms sharp, needle-like crystals that accumulate in joints and surrounding tissues. This triggers sudden, severe attacks of excruciating pain, swelling, redness, and heat, most famously in the base of the big toe, but also in the ankles, knees, wrists, and fingers.

Alternate Names:
Gouty Arthritis; Monosodium Urate Arthropathy; Podagra

Gout Flare

A sudden attack of gout caused by inflammation around urate crystals in a joint. The joint becomes very painful, swollen, warm, and red, often beginning in the big toe. Infection can cause similar symptoms.

Gout Nodulosis

A condition in which many firm urate deposits, called tophi, form under the skin or around joints because of long-standing gout. They may occur at the ears, fingers, toes, elbows, or Achilles tendons and can restrict movement or break through the skin.

Gout Suppressants

An older, imprecise term for urate-lowering medicines used to reduce serum urate and prevent gout flares or urate deposits over time. Examples include xanthine oxidase inhibitors and uricosuric medicines.

Gouty Tophus

A firm deposit of monosodium urate crystals that accumulates in tissues in long-standing gout. Tophi often occur at the ears, elbows, fingers, toes, or Achilles tendons and may limit movement or damage nearby tissue.

Alternate Names:
Tophus

Gowers Sign

A maneuver in which a person uses the hands to push up from the floor or thighs because of proximal muscle weakness, classically seen in muscular dystrophy.

Gower Syndrome

A historical term for episodes William Gowers described as vagal or vasovagal attacks. The name was not consistently adopted and may have included episodes now classified as vasovagal syncope, psychogenic pseudosyncope, or seizures; it is not a current diagnostic term. See also *Vasovagal Syncope* and *Situational Syncope*.

G Protein-Coupled Receptor

A cell-surface receptor that binds hormones, neu-

rotransmitters, medicines, or other signals and activates proteins inside the cell. These receptors regulate many functions, including heart rate, vision, digestion, and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
G Protein-Coupled Receptors; GPCR

Graafian Follicle

A mature, fluid-filled sac in an ovary that contains an egg ready for release. It enlarges during the menstrual cycle and normally opens at ovulation; after release, the remaining tissue forms the corpus luteum.

GRACE Score

A risk score used in people with an acute coronary syndrome to estimate the chance of death or another heart attack during the hospital stay and over the next six months. It uses age, vital signs, kidney function, cardiac arrest, ECG changes, heart-failure signs, and heart-injury blood tests to guide treatment intensity.

Alternate Names:
Global Registry of Acute Coronary Events Score; GRACE Risk Model

Gracilis Muscle

A long, slender strap-like muscle located on the medial aspect of the thigh originating from the inferior pubic ramus and body of the pubis, descending to insert into the pes anserinus on the proximal medial tibia; acts to adduct the thigh and flex and internally rotate the leg.

Grade

A measure of how abnormal cells look under a microscope and, in many cancers, how quickly the growth is likely to behave. Lower grades usually look more like normal cells; higher grades usually look more abnormal. The grading system differs by disease.

Graded Potentials

Small changes in an electrically active cell caused by a stimulus. Their size depends on the stimulus strength, and they can either increase or decrease the chance that the cell will send a nerve signal.

Grade IV Astrocytoma

A historical term for an astrocytoma assigned grade 4 under earlier classification systems. It does not map uniformly to one current tumor type: current classification distinguishes astrocytoma, IDH-mutant, grade 4 from glioblastoma, IDH-wildtype.

Gradenigo Syndrome

A classic clinical triad consisting of suppurative otitis media (otorrhea), retro-orbital or temporal pain in the sensory distribution of the trigeminal nerve (cranial nerve V), and ipsilateral abducens nerve palsy (cranial nerve VI) caused by petrous apicitis.

Alternate Names:
Gradenigo's Syndrome; Petrous Apicitis Triad

Graefe's Sign

A delayed downward movement of the upper eyelid during downward gaze, classically associated with thyroid eye disease but not specific to it.

Graft

Tissue or a synthetic material transferred to another site to replace, repair, reinforce, or bypass a damaged body structure.

Grafting

The surgical transfer of tissue or a synthetic substitute to repair, replace, or support a body structure. An autograft comes from the same person, whereas an allograft comes from another person of the same species.

Graft Versus Host

Alternate name; see *Graft Versus Host Disease*.

Graft Versus Host Disease

A complication of a stem-cell or bone-marrow transplant in which immune cells from the donor attack the recipient's tissues. It commonly affects the skin, liver, and digestive tract and may be short-term or long-lasting; prevention and treatment use immune-suppressing medicines.

Alternate Names:

GVHD

Graft-Versus-Host Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Graft Versus Host Disease*.

Graft-Versus-Host Reaction

Alternate name; see *Graft Versus Host Disease*.

Graham-Little-Piccardi-Lasseur Syndrome

A rare variant of lichen planopilaris characterized by scarring hair loss on the scalp, nonscarring loss of axillary or pubic hair, and follicular papules on the trunk. It is an inflammatory disorder; treatment may limit permanent hair loss.

Gram

A metric unit used to measure mass, equal to one-thousandth of a kilogram. Grams are commonly used for medicines, laboratory samples, food, and body substances; one thousand milligrams make one gram.

Alternate Names:
Metric Gram; Unit G

Gramicidin

Gramicidin is a topical antibiotic that forms channels in bacterial membranes; it is not generally used systemically because it can be toxic.

Gram Mass Unit

Alternate name; see *Gram*.

Gram Metric Unit

Alternate name; see *Gram*.

Gram-Negative

Describing bacteria with a thin peptidoglycan cell wall and an outer membrane containing lipopolysaccharide; they stain pink or red with the Gram stain.

Gram-Negative Bacilli

Rod-shaped bacteria that appear pink or red with a Gram stain because they have a thin peptidoglycan layer and an outer membrane. They include harmless body organisms and bacteria that can cause urinary, respiratory, intestinal, bloodstream, wound, or other infections.

Gram-Negative Bacteria

Bacteria that do not retain crystal violet during Gram staining and therefore appear pink or red. They have a thin peptidoglycan layer and an outer membrane that may contain lipopolysaccharide. Examples include Escherichia coli, Klebsiella, Pseudomonas, and Neisseria.

Gram-Negative Bacterial Resistance

Resistance of gram-negative bacteria to one or more antibiotics. Resistance may be naturally present or acquired through genetic changes or genes transferred from other bacteria. The outer membrane can limit the entry of some antibiotics. Other resistance mechanisms include enzymes that destroy or inactivate antibiotics, changes in drug targets, and pumps that remove antibiotics from bacterial cells.

Gram-Negative Cocci And Coccobacilli

Gram-negative bacteria that are either round or short rod-shaped. Cocci are round, while coccobacilli are short rods that may look almost round. They include bacteria that can cause respiratory, genital, bloodstream, intestinal, and other infections.

Gram-Negative Folliculitis

Inflammation of hair follicles caused by gram-negative bacteria, sometimes after prolonged antibiotic treatment for acne. It often causes pustules on the face, particularly around the mouth and chin.

Gram-Negative Meningitis

Meningitis caused by gram-negative bacteria, including Escherichia coli, Klebsiella, and Neisseria species. It can progress rapidly to sepsis, neurologic injury, and death.

Gram-Negative Toe Web Infection

Infection of the moist spaces between the toes by gram-negative bacteria, causing maceration, erosions, malodor, pain, or discharge. Moisture, occlu-

sive footwear, and existing tinea pedis predispose; drying and appropriate antimicrobial treatment are important.

Gram-Positive

Describing bacteria with a thick peptidoglycan cell wall that retains crystal violet during Gram staining and therefore appears purple.

Gram-Positive Bacilli

Rod-shaped bacteria that retain the purple part of the Gram stain because of their thick peptidoglycan cell wall. Some are harmless colonizers, while others can cause wound, intestinal, respiratory, bloodstream, or nervous-system infections.

Gram-Positive Bacteria

Bacteria that retain crystal violet in the Gram stain (appear purple/blue), characterized by a thick peptidoglycan cell wall and no outer membrane.

Gram-Positive Cocci

Round bacteria that appear purple with a Gram stain because they have a thick peptidoglycan cell wall. Important groups include staphylococci, streptococci, and enterococci, which may normally live on the body or cause skin, throat, lung, urinary, heart-valve, or bloodstream infections.

Gram's Stain

Gram's stain is a laboratory method that classifies bacteria by how their cell walls retain the stain, helping guide identification and initial antibiotic choices.

Gram Stain

A laboratory test that colors bacteria to group them as Gram-positive or Gram-negative. It helps identify possible causes of infection quickly and can guide initial treatment while more specific tests are performed.

Gram Stain Of Skin Lesion

Microscopic examination of a skin lesion specimen stained with Gram stain to identify bacteria. Useful for diagnosing bacterial skin infections and guiding antibiotic therapy. Results available within hours.

Gram Stain Of Tissue Biopsy

Microscopic examination of tissue biopsy specimen stained with Gram stain to identify bacteria. Used to diagnose tissue infections and guide antimicrobial therapy. May be performed alongside culture and histopathology.

Alternate Names:
Tissue Gram Stain; Histochemical Bacterial Stain

Grand Multipara

A person who has given birth five or more times beyond the gestational threshold used to count parity; definitions can vary by obstetric system.

Grand Rounds

An educational medical conference in which clinicians present a case, diagnosis, management, or clinical topic to a professional audience.

Granisetron

Granisetron is a selective 5-HT3-receptor antagonist used to prevent chemotherapy-, radiotherapy-, or surgery-related nausea and vomiting; headache, constipation, and QT prolongation can occur.

Granisetron Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride form of granisetron, a medicine that blocks serotonin 5-HT3 receptors to prevent nausea and vomiting from chemotherapy, radiation, or surgery. Headache, constipation, and heart-rhythm changes may occur.

Granular Casts

Small grainy particles formed inside kidney tubules and seen in urine. They may occur when kidney cells are injured or break down and can be found in acute kidney injury or some chronic kidney diseases.

Granular Cell Tumor Of The Breast

An uncommon tumor showing Schwann-cell differentiation that can occur in the breast and mimic carcinoma clinically or on imaging. Histologic ex-

amination distinguishes it from malignancy; most are benign.

Granular Cell Tumors

Usually slow-growing tumors derived from Schwann-cell-lineage tissue, most often affecting the skin, tongue, or subcutaneous tissue. Most are benign, but some are malignant; persistent or changing nodules require examination and histologic diagnosis.

Granular Leukocyte

A granulocyte, a white blood cell containing cytoplasmic granules; the main types are neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils.

Granular Parakeratosis

A rare skin condition causing brown or reddish, sometimes itchy patches or papules, often in skin folds such as the armpits. It reflects abnormal keratinization and may be difficult to distinguish from other rashes.

Granulation

The formation of new vascular connective tissue during wound healing, producing moist red or pink granulation tissue made of capillaries, fibroblasts, and extracellular matrix.

Granulation Tissue

New tissue that grows in a healing wound and contains small blood vessels, connective tissue, and immune cells. Healthy granulation tissue is usually pink or red and moist.

Granulicatella

Granulicatella is a group of bacteria that may live in the mouth and can rarely cause bloodstream infection or endocarditis.

Granulicatella Adiacens

A mouth bacterium that can rarely cause serious infection, especially infection of heart valves or the bloodstream. It may be difficult to grow in culture, and treatment depends on susceptibility testing.

Granulicatella Elegans

A bacterium normally found in the mouth that can rarely cause bloodstream infection or infection of a heart valve. It may grow poorly in routine culture, so repeated positive cultures and compatible symptoms are important when judging its significance.

Granulocyte

A type of white blood cell containing visible granules. Neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils are granulocytes that help fight infection, trigger inflammation, and respond to allergic or parasitic disease.

Granulocyte Colony-Stimulating Factor

A hematopoietic glycoprotein growth factor that stimulates the bone marrow to produce and differentiate granulocyte precursors into mature neutrophils and mobilize them into circulating blood; recombinant forms (filgrastim, pegfilgrastim) are used to treat and prevent chemotherapy-induced neutropenia.

Alternate Names:
G-CSF

Granulocyte Count

A granulocyte count measures the number of neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils in the blood and helps assess infection, inflammation, and bone-marrow function.

Granulocytic Sarcoma

A mass of immature myeloid blood-forming cells outside the bone marrow, also called myeloid sarcoma. It may occur with acute myeloid leukemia or precede it.

Granulocytopenia

An abnormally low number of granulocytes, especially neutrophils, which can increase susceptibility to bacterial and fungal infection.

Granuloma

A small area of organized inflammation formed when immune cells surround material they cannot easily remove, such as certain germs, foreign material, or

substances released by the body.

Granuloma Annulare

A benign, noninfectious inflammatory skin disorder producing smooth, firm, skin-colored, pink, or reddish papules arranged in ring-shaped plaques, often on the backs of the hands or feet and over joints. It is usually asymptomatic or mildly tender; its cause is unknown.

Granuloma Fungoides

Alternate spelling; see *Mycosis Fungoides*.

Granuloma Gluteale Infantum

A sharply defined reddish-purple inflammatory plaque in the diaper area of an infant, often related to prolonged irritant dermatitis, occlusion, or topical products. Removing irritants and treating the underlying diaper dermatitis usually leads to improvement.

Granuloma Inguinale

A sexually transmitted infection caused by *Klebsiella granulomatis*, producing slowly enlarging, usually painless ulcers in the genital or groin region.

Granulomatosis

A broad term for a disease marked by granulomas, organized clusters of immune cells that form in response to persistent infection, foreign material, or certain inflammatory diseases. It does not identify one specific condition; the particular disease must be named. Granulomatosis with polyangiitis, for example, is a specific disease that inflames blood vessels.

Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis

An autoimmune disease that inflames and damages small and medium-sized blood vessels, often affecting the nose, sinuses, lungs, and kidneys. It may cause sinus problems, cough, coughing blood, or kidney injury.

Alternate Names:
GPA

Granulomatous Amebic Encephalitis

A rare, severe brain infection caused by free-living amoebae, usually in people with weakened immunity. It develops over days or weeks and may cause headache, confusion, seizures, weakness, or coma.

Granulomatous Colitis

Inflammation of the colon in which granulomas are found on tissue examination, often associated with Crohn disease but also possible with infections or other inflammatory conditions.

Granulomatous Inflammation

A pattern of long-lasting inflammation in which immune cells form small clusters around material they cannot easily remove. It can occur with infections, foreign materials, autoimmune disease, or other inflammatory conditions.

Granulomatous Mastitis

Inflammation of the breast in which clusters of immune cells called granulomas form in breast tissue, often around the lobules. Causes include idiopathic disease, infection such as tuberculosis or Corynebacterium, and systemic inflammatory disease; it can cause a painful mass, abscesses, or draining sinuses.

Granulosa Cell

A granulosa cell is a cell surrounding an ovarian egg that supports its development and produces hormones such as estrogen and inhibin.

Granulosa Cell Tumor

A tumor arising from hormone-producing cells in the ovary. It may release estrogen, causing irregular bleeding or early puberty, and can recur years after treatment even when it initially appears slow-growing.

Granulosa Cell Tumors

Plural form; see *Granulosa Cell Tumor*.

Granulosa Tumor

Alternate form; see *Granulosa Cell Tumor*.

Granzyme

A protease released by cytotoxic T lymphocytes and natural killer cells that enters target cells through perforin-associated pores and promotes programmed cell death.

Grasp Reflex

An automatic closing of a baby's fingers when the palm is touched. It is normal in early infancy and usually fades as voluntary hand control develops; persistence or asymmetry can occur with nervous-system problems.

Grass Allergy

An allergic reaction to grass pollen that can cause sneezing, nasal congestion, itchy eyes, and throat irritation. Symptoms may recur during periods when the relevant grass pollen is present in the air.

Alternate Names:
Grass Pollen Allergy; Gramineae Pollinosis

Grass And Weed Killer Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing, inhaling, or getting herbicide on the skin or eyes. Effects range from irritation, vomiting, and breathing problems to severe poisoning, depending on the product and amount.

Alternate Names:
Herbicide Intoxication; Weedicide Poisoning

Graves Disease

An autoimmune disorder that is the leading cause of an overactive thyroid gland (hyperthyroidism). In this condition, the immune system mistakenly produces abnormal antibodies that stimulate the thyroid gland to produce far too much thyroid hormone. This excess hormone speeds up the body's metabolism, causing weight loss despite an increased appetite, rapid or irregular heartbeat, hand tremors, heat intolerance, anxiety, and in many cases, bulging eyes (Graves ophthalmopathy).

Alternate Names:
Graves' Disease; Graves' Disease; Basedow Disease; Toxic Diffuse Goiter

Graves Ophthalmopathy

An autoimmune inflammatory disorder of the retro-orbital tissues and extraocular muscles associated with Graves disease, driven by autoantibodies against the TSH receptor leading to fibroblastic proliferation, glycosaminoglycan deposition, proptosis, upper lid retraction, and diplopia.

Alternate Names:
Graves Orbitopathy; Thyroid Eye Disease

Grave Wax

Alternate name; see *Adipocere*.

Gravida

The number of times a person has been pregnant, regardless of pregnancy outcome; the current pregnancy is included in the count.

Gravidity

Gravidity is the number of times a person has been pregnant, including the current pregnancy and pregnancies that did not result in a live birth.

Gray

A unit used to measure the amount of ionizing radiation absorbed by a material or body tissue. One gray equals one joule of radiation energy absorbed per kilogram. It is used in radiation treatment and safety assessment.

Gray Baby Syndrome

A serious form of chloramphenicol toxicity in newborns, caused by immature drug metabolism and characterized by abdominal distension, vomiting, cyanosis or gray skin color, cardiovascular collapse, and potentially death.

Gray Matter

Areas of the brain and spinal cord containing many nerve-cell bodies and connections. Gray matter processes information and helps control movement, sensation, memory, speech, and other functions.

Greater Curvature

The long, rounded outer border of the stomach,

extending from its upper opening to its outlet. It provides attachment for the greater omentum and receives blood from several stomach arteries.

Greater Omentum

A fold of fatty peritoneal tissue that hangs from the stomach and partly covers the abdominal organs.

Greater Trochanter

The large bony prominence on the outer upper thigh, where several hip muscles attach. It can be felt through the skin and is a common site of pain from tendon problems, bursitis, or injury.

Greater Trochanteric Pain Syndrome

Pain over the outer hip near the greater trochanter, most often associated with gluteal tendon disease and sometimes with nearby bursae. Pain may worsen with walking, climbing stairs, or lying on the affected side.

Alternate Names:
GTPS

Greater Vestibular Glands

Paired glands near the vaginal opening that secrete mucus into the vestibule, contributing to lubrication. They are also called Bartholin glands.

Alternate Names:
Bartholin Glands; Vulvovaginal Glands

Great Saphenous Vein

The longest superficial vein of the lower limb, ascending from the medial foot to drain into the femoral vein at the saphenofemoral junction.

Green Blindness

A form of red-green color-vision deficiency in which distinguishing green from certain other colors is difficult, usually because of an inherited cone-photopigment difference.

Green Nail Syndrome

Green discoloration of one or more nails, usually caused by colonization or infection with Pseudomonas aeruginosa, often in an onycholytic or chronically moist nail.

Greenstick Fracture

An incomplete fracture in which a young bone bends and cracks rather than breaking all the way through.

Green Stool

Stool with a green color that may result from diet, food coloring, rapid intestinal transit, medicines, or infection.

Grenz Zone

A narrow, uninvolved zone of normal collagenous dermis located immediately beneath the epidermis, separating the epidermal basement membrane from a dense underlying dermal cellular infiltrate, classically seen in lepromatous leprosy, granuloma faciale, and cutaneous lymphomas.

Alternate Names:
Subepidermal Grenz Zone; Clear Dermal Zone

Grey Ankle Phenomenon

A gray or dusky discoloration around the ankle associated with chronic venous insufficiency and hemosiderin deposition. It occurs with other signs of venous disease.

Grey Matter

Brain and spinal-cord tissue containing many nerve-cell bodies, connections, and supporting cells. It processes information and helps control movement, sensation, thinking, memory, and other functions.

Grey Turner Sign

Bruise-like discoloration of one or both flanks caused by blood from internal abdominal or retroperitoneal bleeding spreading into the skin. It is classically associated with severe acute pancreatitis but can occur with other causes of internal bleeding; it is uncommon and not specific to pancreatitis.

Grey Turner's Sign

Alternate name; see *Grey Turner Sign*.

Grid Implant

A flexible electrode array placed on or near the brain or another tissue surface to record electrical activity or deliver stimulation.

Grief

The natural emotional response to loss, particularly the death of a loved one, but also following other significant losses such as divorce, job loss, or declining health. It encompasses a range of feelings including sadness, anger, guilt, and numbness, often occurring in waves rather than linear stages.

Grief and Bereavement

Grief is the emotional response to loss, while bereavement is the period of adjustment after a death. Responses vary and may include emotional, physical, social, and spiritual changes.

Grief Disorder

Persistent, intense mourning and functional impairment enduring well beyond typical cultural expectations; see *Complicated Grief*.

Grimontia Hollisae

A salt-loving bacterium from seawater and seafood, formerly called *Vibrio hollisae*. Eating contaminated raw or undercooked seafood can cause watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, and fever; severe infection is uncommon but more likely in people with serious underlying illness.

Griping

Cramping or spasmodic abdominal pain, often caused by contractions, gas, inflammation, or obstruction of a hollow digestive organ.

Grip Strength

The force generated when the hand closes around an object, commonly measured with a dynamometer to assess hand function, muscle strength, nutrition, or rehabilitation progress.

Griscelli Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder causing unusually light or silvery hair and skin pigmentation. Some forms also cause neurologic problems or severe immune overactivation, which can lead to fever, enlarged organs, low blood counts, and life-threatening illness.

Griseofulvin

Griseofulvin is an oral antifungal that deposits in newly formed keratin and disrupts dermatophyte mitosis, treating infections of skin, hair, and nails; treatment is prolonged and hepatic or drug-interaction risks apply.

Groin

The region where the lower abdomen meets the upper thigh, containing the inguinal canal and related muscles, vessels, nerves, and lymph nodes.

Groin Lump

A palpable mass in the inguinal region, which may represent enlarged lymph nodes, a hernia, cyst, tumor, or another condition.

Alternate Names:
Inguinal Mass

Groin Pain

Pain in the inguinal region, which may originate from musculoskeletal, genitourinary, gastrointestinal, or vascular causes. Common causes include muscle strain, hernia, enlarged lymph nodes, and hip disease.

Alternate Names:
Inguinal Pain

Grommet Tube

A miniature, spool-shaped synthetic ventilation tube surgically inserted through an incision in the tympanic membrane (myringotomy) to equalize middle ear pressure and facilitate fluid drainage in chronic otitis media with effusion.

Alternate Names:
Tympanostomy Tube; Ventilation Tube

Groove

A long, narrow depression or channel on a body structure, such as a groove on a bone for a tendon

or a groove between folds of the brain. Its exact function depends on its location.

Grooved Tongue

Alternate name; see *Fissured Tongue*.

Gross Anatomy

The study of body structures visible without a microscope, including organs, body regions, bones, muscles, blood vessels, and their relationships.

Gross Examination

Inspection of a tissue or other specimen with the unaided eye before it is examined under a microscope. The pathologist records its size, shape, color, and visible abnormalities to help guide diagnosis.

Gross Hematuria

Visible blood in the urine, appearing pink, red, or brown. Causes include urinary tract infections, kidney stones, bladder or kidney cancer, trauma, and disease of the kidney filters.

Alternate Names:
Macroscopic Hematuria; Visible Hematuria

Gross Motor Control

The ability to use large muscle groups for coordinated movements such as walking, running, jumping, and maintaining posture. Develops progressively from infancy through childhood and is assessed as part of developmental milestones.

Alternate Names:
Large Motor Coordination

Gross Motor Skills

Movements that use the large muscles for posture, balance, walking, running, jumping, and climbing. Children develop these skills at different rates.

Ground-Glass Opacity

An area of increased whiteness on a lung CT scan through which blood vessels remain visible. It can result from partial filling of air sacs, increased blood volume, or early scarring, and occurs with infections, fluid buildup, bleeding, inflammation, and some tumors. Its distribution and accompanying findings, such as dense consolidation or thickened septa, help narrow the cause.

Ground Itch

An itchy skin rash caused by hookworm larvae entering the skin, usually after bare-foot contact with contaminated soil. It produces small, red, intensely itchy bumps.

Ground Substance

The gel-like, noncellular part of connective tissue surrounding cells and fibers. It contains water, proteoglycans, and other molecules that support tissues, allow nutrient movement, and influence inflammation and repair.

Group 1 Pulmonary Hypertension (PAH)

A type of high blood pressure in the lung arteries caused by narrowing or changes in those vessels. It makes the right side of the heart work harder. Causes include inherited disease, some medicines, and conditions affecting the heart, immune system, or liver.

Group 2 Pulmonary Hypertension

Pulmonary hypertension caused by left-heart disease, including left-ventricular dysfunction, valvular disease, or congenital left-heart disorders. Treatment focuses on the underlying cardiac condition and volume status; pulmonary arterial hypertension-specific drugs are not routinely interchangeable with this group.

Group 3 Pulmonary Hypertension

Pulmonary hypertension associated with lung disease or hypoxia, such as COPD, interstitial lung disease, sleep-disordered breathing, or chronic hypoventilation. Management emphasizes treating the lung disorder, correcting hypoxemia, and evaluating for severe or disproportionate vascular disease.

Group 4 Pulmonary Hypertension

Pulmonary hypertension caused by obstruction of the pulmonary arteries, most commonly chronic thromboembolic pulmonary hypertension from orga-

nized blood clots. Other causes include pulmonary artery tumors, arteritis, and congenital or acquired arterial stenosis.

Group A Strep

Alternate name; see *Group A Streptococcus*.

Group A Streptococcal Infections

Infections caused by Streptococcus pyogenes, including pharyngitis, scarlet fever, impetigo, cellulitis, pneumonia, necrotizing soft-tissue infection, and bloodstream infection. Immune-mediated complications can include rheumatic fever and poststreptococcal glomerulonephritis.

Group A Streptococcus

Streptococcus pyogenes, a bacterium that can cause pharyngitis, skin infections, invasive disease, and immune-mediated complications.

Group B Strep

Alternate name; see *Group B Streptococcus*.

Group B Strep Disease

Illness caused by group B Streptococcus bacteria, which can cause serious infections in newborns and infections in pregnant people or adults with medical risks.

Group B Streptococcal Disease

Alternate name; see *Group B Strep Disease*.

Group B Streptococcal Infection In Pregnancy

Maternal colonization or infection with Streptococcus agalactiae, which can be transmitted to the newborn during labor and cause serious early-onset infection. Screening and intrapartum management reduce neonatal risk.

Group B Streptococcal Infections in Newborns

Alternate name; see *Group B Streptococcal Neonatal Sepsis*.

Group B Streptococcal Neonatal Sepsis

Serious bloodstream infection caused by Group B Streptococcus in neonates, typically acquired during birth. It can cause fever, lethargy, poor feeding, and breathing difficulty; treatment includes antibiotics and supportive care.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Streptococcus Agalactiae Sepsis

Group B Streptococcal Septicemia of the Newborn

Alternate name; see *Group B Streptococcal Neonatal Sepsis*.

Group B Streptococcus

A bacterium that may colonize the bowel or genital tract without symptoms but can cause serious infection in newborns, pregnant people, and some adults. In newborns, infection can cause sepsis, pneumonia, or meningitis.

Alternate Names:
Streptococcus Agalactiae

Group B Streptococcus in Pregnancy

Group B strep bacteria may be present in the bowel or vagina during pregnancy without causing symptoms. Screening late in pregnancy, usually at 36 or 37 weeks, identifies people who may be offered antibiotics during labor to lower the risk of serious newborn infection.

Group Therapy

A form of psychotherapy where a small group of individuals with similar issues meet to discuss, interact, and develop coping strategies under the guidance of a trained therapist. Used for depression, anxiety, substance use disorders, grief, and chronic illness. Benefits include peer support and shared experiences.

Grover Disease

A transient or recurrent acantholytic dermatosis causing itchy red papules or papulovesicles, usually on the trunk of middle-aged or older adults; heat, sweating, and occlusion may aggravate it.

Grover's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Grover Disease*.

Growing Pains

Recurrent, bilateral leg pain in children ages 3-12, typically occurring in the late afternoon or evening and resolving by morning. Pain is deep, aching in the calves, shins, and thighs (not joints). No limping, fever, swelling, or functional impairment.

Growth

The process of increasing in physical size and development, including physical, cognitive, and emotional maturation. In medicine, growth is monitored using growth charts and anthropometric measurements to assess health and development in children.

Growth Chart

A graphical representation of growth (weight, height/length, head circumference, BMI) plotted against age, standardized by population (WHO growth standards 0-5 years; CDC growth charts 2-20 years; percentiles/z-scores).

Growth Cone

A specialized, moving tip at the end of a growing nerve fiber. It senses chemical and physical signals and guides the axon toward its target during nervous-system development or repair.

Growth Disorder

A condition in which a child or adult grows unusually slowly, quickly, or unevenly because of genetic, hormonal, nutritional, chronic, or other medical causes.

Growth Factor

A protein that sends signals controlling cell growth, division, specialization, survival, or repair. Different growth factors act on different tissues and are involved in wound healing, blood-vessel formation, immunity, and cancer.

Growth Failure

Growth that is slower than expected or weight gain that is inadequate for age. It can result from poor nutrition, chronic illness, hormone problems, genetic conditions, or difficulty absorbing nutrients.

Growth Faltering

Alternate name; see *Faltering Weight*.

Growth Hormone

A hormone released by the anterior pituitary that promotes growth partly through insulin-like growth factor 1 and also affects protein, fat, and carbohydrate metabolism.

Growth Hormone Deficiency

Insufficient secretion of growth hormone from the anterior pituitary, causing short stature in children and metabolic effects in adults. In children: delayed growth, short stature, delayed bone age, and increased fat mass. In adults: decreased muscle mass, increased fat mass, reduced bone density, fatigue, and dyslipidemia.

Growth Hormone Deficiency in Adults

Inadequate growth-hormone secretion in adulthood, usually due to hypothalamic or pituitary disease or prior treatment. It may affect body composition, bone density, exercise capacity, lipids, and quality of life and requires confirmatory endocrine testing.

Growth Hormone Physiology

Growth hormone is released in pulses by the pituitary gland, especially during sleep. It acts directly on tissues and also stimulates the liver to produce insulin-like growth factor 1, which supports bone and tissue growth.

Growth Hormone-Releasing Hormone

A 44-amino-acid hypothalamic peptide hormone synthesized by neurons of the arcuate nucleus that travels via the hypophyseal portal system to bind G-protein coupled receptors on anterior pituitary somatotropes, stimulating growth hormone synthesis and pulsatile secretion.

Alternate Names:
GHRH; Somatoliberin

Growth Hormone Stimulation Test

A test for suspected growth-hormone deficiency. A medicine or other controlled stimulus is given, and blood samples are taken over time to see whether the pituitary gland releases enough growth hormone. Results depend on the protocol and laboratory.

Alternate Names:
GH Provocation Test

Growth Hormone Suppression Test

A test for excess growth hormone, usually performed after drinking a glucose solution. In healthy people, glucose lowers growth-hormone levels; failure to suppress them supports a diagnosis such as acromegaly.

Alternate Names:
GH Suppression Test; Glucose Loading GH Assay

Growth Hormone Test

Laboratory measurement of growth hormone levels in the blood, used to evaluate GH deficiency or excess. Random GH levels have limited utility; stimulation or suppression tests are more informative.

Growth Medium

A nutrient preparation supporting microbial multiplication in vitro, supplying carbon, nitrogen, minerals, and growth factors in liquid or solid form.

Growth Plate

A layer of cartilage near the end of a growing bone where the bone lengthens. It gradually closes after puberty.

Growth Plate Fracture

A break involving the cartilage growth area of a child's or adolescent's bone. It can disturb future growth if displaced or untreated; imaging and specialist management may be used.

Alternate Names:
Physeal Fractures

Growth Plate Fractures

Plural form; see *Growth Plate Fracture*.

Growth Retardation

Older wording for growth that is slower than expected for age or developmental stage. Possible causes include inadequate nutrition, chronic illness, hormone or genetic disorders, poor absorption, and normal family variation; growth is assessed over time rather than by one measurement.

Growth Scan

An ultrasound examination used to assess fetal size, growth pattern, amniotic fluid, and sometimes blood flow. Measurements are compared with gestational-age standards to identify possible growth restriction or excessive growth.

Gtp Binding

GTP binding is the attachment of guanosine triphosphate to a protein, often switching that protein into an active state for cell signaling.

Gtt.

An abbreviation from the Latin *guttae*, meaning drops. It refers to a liquid dose or the number of drops.

Guaifenesin

An expectorant used to loosen respiratory mucus and make coughing more productive. It provides symptomatic relief in some respiratory illnesses; dosing depends on the formulation and patient.

Guanfacine

Guanfacine is a centrally acting alpha-2A adrenergic agonist used for hypertension and, in extended-release form, ADHD; sedation, hypotension, bradycardia, and rebound hypertension after abrupt withdrawal are important risks.

Guanine

Guanine is a purine nitrogenous base in DNA and RNA; it pairs with cytosine and is present in nucleotides such as GMP and GTP that support energy transfer and signaling.

Guanosinetriphosphatase

An enzyme that hydrolyzes guanosine triphosphate to guanosine diphosphate and phosphate, regulating signaling and other cellular processes.

Guanosine Triphosphate

A guanine nucleotide that provides energy and acts as a molecular switch in protein synthesis, cytoskeletal regulation, and G-protein signaling.

Guanylate Cyclase

Guanylate cyclase is an enzyme that converts GTP to cyclic GMP, a second messenger involved in nitric-oxide signaling, smooth-muscle relaxation, phototransduction, and intestinal fluid secretion.

Guarana

A plant whose seeds contain caffeine and other stimulants. It is used in energy products and supplements; excessive intake may cause anxiety, insomnia, rapid heartbeat, high blood pressure, or interactions with medicines.

Guarding

Involuntary tightening of the abdominal muscles when the abdomen is examined, often reflecting irritation or inflammation of the abdominal lining.

Guenther Porphyria

Alternate spelling; see *Gunther Disease*.

Guevedoces

A term used in the Dominican Republic for individuals with 46,XY differences in sex development caused by 5-alpha-reductase type 2 deficiency; they may have female-appearing or ambiguous external genitalia at birth and increased virilization at puberty.

Guide Device

A tool used to direct, position, or stabilize another instrument during a procedure, such as a guidewire, drill guide, or needle guide. It helps ensure accurate placement and reduces injury to surrounding tissue.

Guided Imagery

Guided imagery is a relaxation technique that uses imagined sights, sounds, or other sensations to promote calm and sometimes help manage pain or stress.

Guided Tissue Regeneration

A dental procedure placing a barrier membrane to encourage regrowth of bone, root covering, and supporting ligament around a tooth. It may repair selected periodontal defects after inflammation is controlled.

Guidewire

A thin, flexible wire introduced through a blood vessel or body passage to guide placement of a catheter, sheath, stent, or other medical device.

Guillain-Barre Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Guillain-Barré Syndrome*.

Guillain-Barré Syndrome

A rare, serious neurological disorder in which the body's immune system mistakenly attacks the peripheral nervous system, usually triggered one to four weeks after a viral or bacterial respiratory or digestive infection. The immune attack damages the protective coating around nerves, leading to symmetrical muscle weakness and tingling that characteristically begins in the feet and legs and spreads upward to the arms and upper body. In severe cases, the weakness can paralyze the breathing muscles or affect heart rhythm and blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
GBS; Acute Inflammatory Demyelinating Polyradiculoneuropathy; AIDP

Guillaume Dupuytren

A French surgeon whose name is associated with Dupuytren contracture, progressive thickening and shortening of palmar fascia that bends the fingers toward the palm.

Guinea Worm

A parasitic infection caused by Dracunculus medi-

nensis, acquired by drinking water containing infected copepods and characterized by emergence of a long worm through the skin.

Guinea Worm Infection

Alternate name; see *Guinea Worm*.

Gulf War Syndrome

A term for a group of persistent symptoms reported by some Gulf War veterans, such as fatigue, pain, cognitive difficulties, gastrointestinal symptoms, and respiratory problems. The term chronic multisymptom illness is also used for this symptom complex.

Alternate Names:
Gulf War Illness

Gullet

The esophagus, a muscular tube carrying swallowed food and liquid from the throat to the stomach. It moves contents by coordinated squeezing and is protected from injury by its moist inner lining.

Alternate Names:
Esophagus; Food Pipe

Gum

The soft tissue around the teeth that covers the jawbone and helps hold the teeth in place.

Alternate Names:
Gingiva; Gingival Mucosa

Gum Biopsy

Histological examination of gingival tissue obtained by biopsy, used to diagnose gingival diseases, infections, or malignancies. May involve excisional or incisional biopsy techniques.

Alternate Names:
Gingival Biopsy; Periodontal Tissue Sampling

Gum Disease

A broad term for conditions affecting the gums and tooth-supporting tissues. Gingivitis causes gum inflammation; periodontitis also damages the supporting ligament and bone and may loosen teeth.

Alternate Names:
Periodontal Disease

Gum Hypertrophy

Alternate name; see *Gingival Hyperplasia*.

Gumma

A soft area of tissue damage caused by late untreated syphilis. It can develop in the skin, bones, liver, or other organs and may cause a lump, pain, or organ damage.

Alternate Names:
Syphilitic Gumma; Tertiary Syphilis Granuloma

Gummata

More than one gumma: soft inflammatory masses caused by late untreated syphilis. They can affect skin, bone, liver, or other organs and may damage tissue.

Gummy Smile

A smile showing more gum than usual. It may result from lip movement, tooth eruption, jaw shape, or gum position; treatment is optional and depends on the cause and the person's goals.

Gum Problems

Gum problems include inflammation, bleeding, recession, ulcers, infection, trauma, and growths. Causes include plaque, tobacco, dry mouth, medicines, nutritional or immune disease, and poorly fitting appliances.

Gums

Plural form; see *Gum*.

Gunn Sign

An ophthalmologic sign of hypertensive retinopathy in which an arteriosclerotic, rigid retinal arteriole crosses and compresses an underlying retinal venule, producing visible tapering and apparent deflection of the venule on both sides of the crossing.

Alternate Names:
Gunn's Sign; Arteriovenous Nicking

Gunshot Wound

An injury caused by a firearm projectile. Damage may include bleeding, tissue destruction, fractures, nerve injury, organ damage, and infection.

Alternate Names:
Firearm Injury; Ballistic Trauma; Bullet Wound

Gunther Disease

A severe autosomal recessive disorder of heme biosynthesis caused by a deficiency of uroporphyrinogen III synthase, leading to massive accumulation of isomer I porphyrins in tissues, manifesting with extreme cutaneous photosensitivity, blistering, mutilating scar formation, erythrodontia, and hemolytic anemia.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Erythropoietic Porphyria; CEP

Gustation

The sense of taste. Special cells in taste buds detect sweet, salty, sour, bitter, and savory flavors. Most taste buds are on the tongue, with some in the soft palate and throat. Signals travel through several head nerves to the brain. Taste can change with infections, medicines, smoking, aging, or damage to the mouth or nerves.

Gustatory

Relating to taste or the sense of taste, including taste buds, taste nerves, and the brain pathways that interpret flavors.

Gustatory Lacrimation

Excessive tearing triggered by eating or smelling food, usually after an injury to the facial nerve or recovery from facial paralysis. The nerve signals for saliva and tears become incorrectly linked.

Gustatory Sweating

Sweating triggered by eating or thinking about food, usually over the cheek or temple after injury or surgery involving the parotid region.

Alternate Names:
Frey Syndrome

Gut

Alternate informal term; see *Digestive Tract*.

Gut-Brain Axis

The two-way communication between the digestive tract and brain through nerves, hormones, immune signals, and substances made by gut microorganisms. It influences digestion, appetite, stress responses, and mood, but its clinical importance is still being studied.

Gut Epithelium

The layer of cells lining the intestines. It absorbs nutrients and water, forms a barrier against harmful substances, and interacts with immune cells and gut microorganisms.

Guthrie Test

An older name for a newborn blood-spot screening test, originally used to detect phenylketonuria. Modern screening covers more conditions; an abnormal result is followed by confirmatory testing.

Gut Microbiome

The complex community of trillions of microorganisms, including bacteria, viruses, and fungi, residing in the gastrointestinal tract. The gut microbiome plays a crucial role in digestion, immune function, vitamin synthesis, and protection against pathogens.

Guttae

Drop-like excrescences of Descemet membrane on the inner surface of the cornea, often associated with Fuchs endothelial corneal dystrophy. Extensive guttae can disrupt corneal endothelial cells and contribute to corneal swelling and blurred vision.

Guttate Psoriasis

A form of psoriasis causing many small, scaly, drop-shaped spots, often after a streptococcal throat infection. It commonly affects children or young adults and may clear, recur, or later become plaque psoriasis.

Guttural

Relating to the throat. A guttural sound is produced mainly in the throat or back of the mouth rather than at the front of the tongue and lips.

Guyon Canal Syndrome

An entrapment neuropathy of the ulnar nerve as it passes through Guyon canal (the fibro-osseous ulnar tunnel at the wrist between the pisiform and hook of the hamate), causing sensory loss over the little finger and medial half of the ring finger and motor weakness of the hypothenar and interosseous muscles.

Alternate Names:
Ulnar Tunnel Syndrome; Handlebar Palsy

GVHD

Abbreviation; see *Graft Versus Host Disease*.

Gymnast Wrist

A chronic overuse repetitive stress injury of the distal radial growth plate (physis) occurring in skeletally immature gymnasts and athletes who subject the upper extremities to intense axial loading and hyperextension. Radiographs typically demonstrate distal radial physeal widening, irregular metaphyseal margins, and cystic changes.

Alternate Names:
Distal Radial Physeal Stress Syndrome; Gymnast's Epiphysitis

Gynaecologist

A medical doctor who specializes in the health of the female reproductive system (vagina, cervix, uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries) and breasts.

Gynaecology

The medical specialty concerned with the female reproductive system, including the ovaries, fallopian tubes, uterus, cervix, vagina, and vulva, as well as related hormonal health.

Gynaecomastia

Alternate name; see *Gynecomastia*.

Gynatresia

Absence of or blockage in an opening of the female reproductive tract, present from birth or acquired later. If menstrual blood cannot leave the body, it may cause absent periods, pelvic pain, or enlargement of the uterus or vagina.

Gynecic

Relating to the female reproductive system or to gynecology.

Gynecoid Pelvis

A commonly described pelvic shape with a rounded inlet, relatively broad dimensions, and a spacious outlet; it is associated with typical female pelvic anatomy but individual variation is substantial.

Gynecological Examination

A gynecological examination assesses the female reproductive organs and may include inspection, a pelvic examination, and screening tests when appropriate.

Gynecologic Oncology

The subspecialty of medicine focused on cancers of the female reproductive organs, including cancers of the ovaries, uterus, cervix, vagina, and vulva. It includes diagnosis and cancer-directed care, often coordinating surgery, medicines, radiation, pathology, and supportive services.

Gynecologic Pain

Pain arising from the vulva, vagina, cervix, uterus, tubes, ovaries, pelvic floor, or related nerves and organs. Causes include infection, endometriosis, cysts, torsion, pregnancy complications, malignancy, musculoskeletal disease, and neuropathic or chronic pain.

Gynecologic Tumor Markers

Blood or tissue measurements that may support diagnosis, staging, treatment selection, or monitoring of gynecologic tumors. They are not usually diagnostic alone because benign conditions and other cancers can also alter marker levels.

Gynecologist

A gynecologist is a physician who provides care for the female reproductive system, including preventive care, diagnosis, and treatment.

Gynecology

The medical specialty concerned with the health of the female reproductive system (uterus, ovaries, fallopian tubes, cervix, vagina, and vulva).

Gynecomastia

Benign growth of glandular breast tissue in boys or men, distinct from breast enlargement caused only by extra fat. It commonly occurs in newborns, during puberty, and with aging; changes in hormone balance, some medicines, or illness can also cause it.

Alternate Names:
Gynaecomastia; Male Breast Enlargement; Breast Enlargement in Males

Gyrate Atrophy

An inherited retinal disorder causing gradually worsening peripheral and night vision loss. It results from abnormal ornithine metabolism and may be managed with dietary treatment, supplements, and regular eye monitoring.

Gyrus

A raised fold on the surface of the brain, separated from neighboring folds by grooves called sulci. These folds increase the cerebral cortex's surface area within the skull and contain areas responsible for different functions.

H

H1N1 Flu

Alternate name; see *H1N1 Influenza*.

H1N1 Influenza

Influenza A infection caused by an H1N1 virus. It spreads through respiratory droplets and commonly causes sudden fever, cough, sore throat, muscle aches, headache, and tiredness; some people develop pneumonia or severe breathing problems.

H1N2

A subtype of influenza A virus that can infect humans and pigs. Human infections are uncommon and usually cause an influenza-like respiratory illness; surveillance and testing help distinguish it from other influenza viruses.

H2 Blockers

Medicines that reduce stomach-acid production by blocking histamine H2 receptors in the stomach. They can relieve heartburn and treat some ulcers; possible adverse effects include headache, diarrhea, constipation, and interactions with other medicines.

Alternate Names:
H2 Receptor Antagonists; Histamine-2 Receptor Blockers

H2 Receptor Antagonists Overdose

Taking too much of an H2 blocker medicine. It may cause drowsiness, confusion, agitation, abnormal heartbeat, or rarely seizures.

H5N1

A subtype of avian influenza A virus that mainly infects birds but can occasionally infect mammals and humans after close contact with infected animals or contaminated environments. Human illness can be severe.

Habenula

A small brain structure helping process reward, unpleasant experiences, stress, motivation, and learned behavior. It connects several brain regions and may influence mood, sleep, pain, and responses to negative outcomes.

Haberland Syndrome (Encephalocraniocutaneous Lipomatosis)

A rare congenital mosaic disorder characterized by unilateral scalp and facial lipomas or hairless skin lesions, eye abnormalities, and sometimes seizures, developmental differences, or brain malformations.

Habit

A repeated behavior or pattern of action that may be ordinary, helpful, or harmful; in clinical assessment, its frequency, control, and effect on functioning determine whether it is a concern.

Habit-Tic Nail Deformity

Nail damage caused by repeated rubbing, picking, or pushing back the skin at the nail base. It often produces a central groove with rows of horizontal ridges, especially on the thumbnails. The repeated trauma can disturb nail growth and resembles median canaliform nail dystrophy.

Habituation

A gradual reduction in response to a repeated, harmless stimulus. For example, a person may stop

noticing a constant sound; habituation differs from addiction or drug tolerance.

Habitus

A person's general body build and appearance as observed during a medical examination. Clinicians may describe body habitus when noting nutritional state, muscle mass, or features relevant to a condition.

HAE

Abbreviation for hereditary angioedema, an inherited disorder causing repeated episodes of swelling; see *Hereditary Angioedema*.

Haem

The iron-containing part of hemoglobin that binds oxygen inside red blood cells. Its structure allows blood to carry oxygen from the lungs to tissues and return carbon dioxide.

Haemangioma

Alternate spelling; see *Hemangioma*.

Haemarthrosis

Bleeding into a joint, causing swelling, pain, and reduced movement. It may follow an injury or occur with hemophilia, blood-thinning medicines, surgery, or certain joint disorders.

Haematemesis

Vomiting blood or material that looks like coffee grounds, usually from bleeding in the esophagus, stomach, or upper small intestine. It can be life-threatening.

Haematinics

Nutrients or medicines needed to make healthy red blood cells, especially iron, vitamin B12, and folate. Deficiency can cause anemia, although treatment depends on the specific cause.

Haematocele

A collection of blood in a body cavity or tissue, often in the scrotum after injury, surgery, or bleeding. It may cause swelling, pain, or pressure and sometimes needs imaging or drainage.

Haematocolpos

Accumulation of menstrual blood in the vagina, usually because the vaginal opening is blocked or too narrow. It can cause absent periods, monthly pelvic pain, and a swollen vagina or uterus.

Haematocrit

The proportion of blood volume occupied by red blood cells, expressed as a percentage or decimal fraction. The reference range varies with age, sex, altitude, pregnancy, and laboratory method.

Haematogenous

Spread through the bloodstream. An infection, cancer, or other material that travels this way can reach organs or tissues far from its original site.

Haematologist

A medical doctor who specializes in the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of diseases of the blood and blood-forming organs.

Haematoma

A collection of blood outside a blood vessel, usually caused by injury, surgery, bleeding disorders, or blood-thinning medicines. A hematoma may cause swelling and pain and can compress nearby organs or nerves.

Haematometra

A collection of menstrual blood in the uterus, usually because the cervix or vagina is blocked or absent. It may cause missed periods, recurring pelvic pain, and uterine enlargement.

Haematomyelia

Bleeding into the spinal cord, usually after severe injury or because of an abnormal blood vessel or bleeding disorder. It can cause sudden back pain, weakness, numbness, paralysis, or loss of bladder control.

Haematopericardium

Blood within the sac around the heart, usually after chest injury, heart surgery, or a tear in the heart or a blood vessel. It can compress the heart and cause life-threatening tamponade.

Haematopoiesis

The process of making blood cells, mainly inside the bone marrow. It produces red cells that carry oxygen, white cells that fight infection, and platelets that help stop bleeding.

Haematoporphyria

An obsolete general term for porphyria, a group of disorders caused by problems in heme production that lead to a buildup of porphyrins or their precursors. The term does not identify a specific type of porphyria.

Haematosalpinx

Alternate spelling; see *Hematosalpinx*.

Haematuria

Blood in the urine. It may be visible or found only with a urine test and can have many causes, including infection, stones, medicines, or kidney disease.

Haemochromatosis

Alternate spelling; see *Hemochromatosis*.

Haemodialysis

Alternate spelling; see *Hemodialysis*.

Haemoflagellate

A parasite with a whip-like structure that lives in blood or tissues. Examples include the parasites that cause sleeping sickness and Chagas disease.

Haemoglobin

The iron-containing protein inside red blood cells that carries oxygen from the lungs to tissues and helps return carbon dioxide to the lungs. A low level is anemia; an abnormal form can cause disease.

Haemoglobinopathy

An inherited disorder affecting the amount or structure of hemoglobin, the oxygen-carrying protein in red blood cells. Examples include sickle-cell disease and thalassemia, which can cause anemia or other complications.

Haemoglobinuria

Free hemoglobin in the urine, often released when red blood cells break apart in the bloodstream. It can make urine red or brown and may occur with infections, medicines, burns, or blood disorders.

Haemolysis

The breakdown of red blood cells, which releases hemoglobin into the blood. It can happen normally as old cells are removed or too quickly because of disease.

Haemolytic Anaemia

Anemia caused by red blood cells being destroyed faster than the bone marrow can replace them. It may cause tiredness, jaundice, dark urine, rapid heartbeat, breathlessness, or an enlarged spleen.

Haemolytic Disease Of The Newborn

Anemia and jaundice in a newborn caused by antibodies from the pregnant person crossing the placenta and destroying the baby's red blood cells. Severe cases can cause brain injury from bilirubin accumulation.

Haemoperitoneum

Bleeding into the abdominal cavity, commonly after injury, a ruptured ectopic pregnancy, or a bleeding liver, spleen, artery, or other organ. It can cause shock.

Haemophilia

Alternate spelling; see *Hemophilia*.

Haemophilia A

Hemophilia A, an inherited bleeding disorder caused by deficiency or dysfunction of clotting factor VIII. It can cause prolonged bleeding, easy bruising, and

bleeding into joints or muscles; treatment replaces or stimulates factor VIII activity.

Haemophilus

A group of bacteria that may live harmlessly in the nose and throat or cause infection. Depending on the species, illness can affect the ears, sinuses, lungs, blood, joints, or brain coverings.

Haemophilus Aegyptius

A bacterium associated with eye infections and, rarely, severe bloodstream disease. It can spread through respiratory secretions or direct contact, and laboratory identification helps guide treatment and public-health precautions.

Haemophilus Ducreyi

A fastidious, facultatively anaerobic Gram-negative coccobacillus that is the causative etiological agent of chancroid, characterized by painful, non-indurated genital ulcers with purulent bases and prominent suppurative inguinal lymphadenopathy (buboes).

Haemophilus Haemolyticus

A bacterium that commonly lives harmlessly in the upper airway but can occasionally cause respiratory or invasive infection, especially in people with weakened immunity or serious underlying illness.

Haemophilus Infections

Infections caused by Haemophilus bacteria, which may affect the ears, sinuses, lungs, bloodstream, joints, or brain coverings. Severity depends on the species, infection site, age, vaccination, and immune health.

Haemophilus Influenzae

A type of bacteria that can cause ear infections, pneumonia, meningitis, and other infections. Type b, or Hib, can cause severe disease in children, but vaccination greatly reduces this risk.

Haemophilus Parainfluenzae

A small gram-negative bacterium that normally colonizes the upper respiratory tract but can rarely cause respiratory, bloodstream, or other opportunistic infections.

Haemoptysis

Coughing up blood or blood-stained mucus from the airways or lungs. Causes include infection, bronchiectasis, a blood clot, cancer, or irritation; larger amounts may occur with breathlessness or chest pain.

Haemorrhage

British spelling of Hemorrhage; see Hemorrhage.

Haemorrhagic Fever

A group of severe infections caused by certain viruses that can damage blood vessels and disrupt clotting. Fever, weakness, bleeding, shock, and organ failure may occur.

Haemorrhagic Fever With Renal Syndrome

A hantavirus infection usually acquired by inhaling dust contaminated with infected rodent urine or droppings. It causes fever, headache, bleeding, low blood pressure, and temporary kidney failure and may be severe.

Haemorrhagic Stroke

A stroke caused by a burst blood vessel in the brain or in the space around it. The bleeding injures brain tissue and may cause sudden weakness, speech trouble, severe headache, vomiting, or loss of consciousness.

Haemorrhoids

Alternate spelling; see *Hemorrhoids*.

Haemosiderin

A brownish iron-storage material that forms inside cells when iron accumulates, often after repeated bleeding, transfusions, or excess iron absorption. Large deposits can contribute to tissue damage.

Haemosiderosis

Excess deposition of haemosiderin, an iron-storage pigment, in tissues. Deposits may be focal after bleeding into a tissue or widespread after repeated transfusions or excess iron absorption; widespread iron can injure the liver, heart, or hormone-producing organs.

Haemostasis

The body's normal process for stopping bleeding. Blood vessels narrow, platelets form a temporary plug, and clotting proteins strengthen it with a stable clot.

Haemostat

A substance, device, or instrument used to control bleeding. It may work by pressing on a vessel, sealing tissue, promoting clotting, or temporarily blocking blood flow during an operation.

Haemothorax

Blood collecting between the lung and chest wall, usually after chest injury, surgery, or a medical procedure. It can compress the lung, cause breathing difficulty or shock, and may require drainage.

Haff Disease

Sudden muscle breakdown and severe muscle pain after eating certain contaminated fish or seafood. It can release muscle proteins that damage the kidneys; treatment includes fluids and monitoring for complications.

Hafnia

A genus of gram-negative intestinal bacteria; Hafnia alvei is the species most often identified in human specimens.

Hafnia Alvei

A Gram-negative bacterium found in the intestine and environment that rarely causes opportunistic infection, usually in people with serious illness or weakened immunity.

Hageman Factor

An older name for factor XII, a blood protein that helps start one pathway of clotting. Factor XII deficiency can prolong a laboratory clotting test but usually does not cause abnormal bleeding.

Haglund Deformity

An anatomical prominence (posterosuperior calcaneal exostosis) of the heel bone causing mechanical friction and chronic inflammation of the retrocalcaneal bursa and Achilles tendon, exacerbated by rigid shoes ('pump bump').

Alternate Names:
Retrocalcaneal Exostosis; Pump Bump

Hailey-Hailey Disease

An inherited skin disorder that causes repeated blisters, raw areas, and painful cracks, especially in skin folds such as the neck, armpits, and groin. Heat, sweating, friction, and infection can trigger flares.

Hair

Keratinized filaments produced by follicles in the skin. Hair protects the scalp, contributes to temperature regulation and sensation, and grows through anagen, catagen, and telogen phases.

Hair-Ball

A hair-ball, or trichobezoar, is a mass of swallowed hair in the stomach or intestine, usually associated with repeated hair eating.

Hair Bleach Poisoning

Illness after swallowing or inhaling hair-bleaching chemicals, which may contain peroxide or persulfates. They can irritate or burn the mouth, throat, skin, eyes, or lungs.

Hair Bulb

The rounded base of a hair follicle where new hair is produced. It contains growing cells and a small blood-supplied area that provides nutrients and helps determine hair growth and color.

Hair Cells

Special cells in the inner ear that change sound vibrations and head movement into nerve signals for hearing and balance.

Hair Disease

A disorder affecting hair growth, the hair shaft, or the scalp; causes include genetics, inflammation, infection, medicines, and nutritional problems.

Hair Dye Poisoning

Harm caused by swallowing or inhaling hair-dye chemicals. Depending on the ingredients and amount, symptoms may include vomiting, swelling, breathing difficulty, allergic reaction, kidney injury, or muscle damage.

Hair Follicle

A small tube in the skin that produces a hair. Each follicle has a growth phase, a brief transition phase, and a resting phase.

Hair Loss

Partial or complete loss of hair from areas where it normally grows, most often the scalp. Causes include inherited pattern hair loss, alopecia areata, illness, medicines, hormonal changes, and some nutritional deficiencies.

Alternate Names:
Alopecia; Baldness

Hair Loss Classification

Hair loss is classified as scarring or nonscarring. Scarring hair loss destroys follicles and is usually permanent; nonscarring loss leaves follicles intact and may improve when its cause, such as illness, medicines, stress, or autoimmune disease, is treated.

Hair-Pulling Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Trichotillomania*.

Hair Removal

Removal of unwanted hair by shaving, trimming, waxing, depilatory products, electrolysis, or laser treatment. Possible problems include irritation, burns, ingrown hairs, pigment changes, and infection.

Hair Shaft

The part of a hair that extends above the skin. It is made of dead, hardened cells produced by the follicle and can be affected by cutting, heat, chemicals, friction, or damage to the hair root.

Hair Spray Poisoning

Illness after swallowing or inhaling hair spray. Small accidental exposures may irritate the mouth or lungs, while larger exposures can cause vomiting, drowsiness, breathing problems, or chemical injury.

Hair Straightener Poisoning

Harm after swallowing a hair-straightening product, which may contain corrosive chemicals. It can burn the mouth, throat, esophagus, or stomach and cause breathing or swallowing problems.

Hair Tonic Poisoning

Illness after swallowing or inhaling a hair-tonic product. Ingredients such as alcohols or solvents may cause vomiting, drowsiness, low blood sugar, or breathing problems; the product and amount determine severity.

Hair Tourniquet

Circumferential constriction of a finger, toe, external genital structure, or other appendage by a strand of hair, thread, or similar fiber. The resulting swelling can tighten the band further, reduce blood flow, and cause tissue injury or tissue death. It occurs most often in infants and young children.

Alternate Names:
Hair Tourniquet Syndrome; Hair-Thread Tourniquet Syndrome

Hair Transplant

A procedure that moves hair follicles, usually from a donor area of the scalp, to areas affected by permanent hair loss; results depend on diagnosis, donor supply, technique, and postoperative care.

Hairy Cell Leukaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Hairy Cell Leukemia*.

Hairy Cell Leukemia

A rare, usually slow-growing cancer of a type of white blood cell. Abnormal cells build up in the bone marrow, blood, and spleen, causing low blood counts, infections, tiredness, or an enlarged spleen.

Alternate Names:
HCL; Leukemic Reticuloendotheliosis

Hairy Leukoplakia

A painless, white, ridged patch that usually appears on the sides of the tongue and cannot be scraped off. It is caused by Epstein-Barr virus and occurs mainly in people with a weakened immune system, especially those with HIV.

Alternate Names:
Oral Hairy Leukoplakia; OHL

Hairy Tongue

A usually harmless elongation and discoloration of the tongue's surface papillae, often appearing black, brown, or white. It may be associated with smoking, dry mouth, poor oral hygiene, or some medicines, including antibiotics.

Hajdu-Cheney Syndrome

A rare inherited bone disorder causing fragile bones, short stature, abnormal skull and facial development, and sometimes loose joints or dental problems. Severity varies, and specialist monitoring helps prevent complications.

Halcinonide

A potent topical corticosteroid used to reduce inflammation and itching in steroid-responsive dermatitis and other inflammatory skin disorders; prolonged or extensive use can cause skin atrophy and systemic effects.

Haldane Effect

The effect of oxygen binding to hemoglobin in the lungs, which helps release carbon dioxide for exhalation. In body tissues, hemoglobin without oxygen carries more carbon dioxide back toward the lungs.

Half-Life

The time it takes for the amount of a medicine in the body, or its blood level, to decrease by half. It influences dosing intervals and how long a medicine remains in the body.

Alternate Names:
Terminal Half-Life; t1/2

Halitosis

Persistent unpleasant breath odor, most often from bacteria on the tongue, teeth, or gums. Dry mouth, smoking, foods, sinus or throat disease, reflux, and some illnesses or medicines can also contribute.

Alternate Names:
Bad Breath; Oral Malodor; Fetor Oris

Hallermann's Syndrome

A rare congenital disorder characterized by distinctive craniofacial development, sparse hair, dental abnormalities, and sometimes eye or skeletal findings.

Alternate Names:
Hallermann-Streiff Syndrome

Hallpike Test

A clinical vestibular provocative maneuver used to diagnose benign paroxysmal positional vertigo (BPPV) of the posterior semicircular canal; the patient is rapidly lowered from a sitting position to supine with the head extended and turned 45 degrees, provoking rotational upbeat nystagmus and vertigo.

Alternate Names:
Dix-Hallpike Test; Nylan-Barany Test

Hallucination

A sensory experience that feels real but occurs without a matching external stimulus. It may involve seeing, hearing, feeling, smelling, or tasting something that is not present.

Hallucinations

Plural form; see *Hallucination*.

Hallucinogen

A psychoactive substance that can alter perception, thought, and mood and may produce hallucinations; effects and toxicity vary by substance, dose, co-ingestants, and mental state.

Hallux

The great toe, or big toe. It has two bones and helps the foot stay stable and push off during walking. Common problems include hallux valgus (a bunion), hallux rigidus (a stiff, arthritic joint), turf toe (a sprain), and gout causing sudden pain and swelling at the joint where the toe meets the foot.

Hallux Rigidus

Arthritis of the joint where the big toe meets the foot, causing pain, stiffness, swelling, and reduced upward movement. A bony bump may develop and make walking or wearing shoes difficult.

Hallux Valgus

A bunion: a change in the alignment of the joint at the base of the big toe, with the toe pointing inward and a prominent area on the inner forefoot. It may become painful from pressure or inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Bunion; Hallux Abductovalgus

Hallux Varus

Abnormal medial deviation of the great toe, often following surgery, trauma, neuromuscular imbalance, or congenital deformity; it can cause shoe difficulty and pressure-related pain.

Halogen

An element in group 17 of the periodic table, including fluorine, chlorine, bromine, iodine, and astatine; halogens and their compounds have medical, biologic, and toxicologic importance.

Halo Nevus

A usually harmless mole surrounded by a ring of lighter skin. The immune system causes the mole and nearby pigment cells to lose color; it often occurs in children or young adults and may slowly fade.

Haloperidol

Haloperidol is a first-generation antipsychotic that blocks dopamine D2 receptors and is used for psychosis, agitation, delirium, and tics; extrapyramidal reactions, tardive dyskinesia, hyperprolactinaemia, and QT prolongation are important risks.

Halo Sign

A ground-glass rim around a pulmonary nodule or area of consolidation on computed tomography. It is a nonspecific finding that can occur with infection, including invasive fungal disease in immunocompromised people, as well as hemorrhage, inflammation, or neoplasm.

Halothane

A volatile inhaled anesthetic formerly used to induce or maintain general anesthesia; it can cause hypotension, arrhythmias, and rare severe immune-mediated liver injury.

Halushi-Behcet's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Behcet Disease*.

Hamamelis

A botanical preparation from witch hazel used topically as an astringent for minor skin or mucosal irritation; evidence and product composition vary.

Hamartoma

A usually harmless growth made of an abnormal arrangement of tissue types normally found in that part of the body. It may occur in organs such as the lung, skin, brain, or intestine and may cause problems if it grows or presses on nearby structures.

Hamartomatous Polyposis

A condition in which multiple hamartomatous gastrointestinal polyps develop from disorganized but benign tissue overgrowth, sometimes as part of an inherited cancer-predisposition syndrome.

Hamate

A small, wedge-shaped bone on the little-finger side of the wrist. Its hook provides attachment for liga-

ments and tendons; fractures there may cause wrist pain or pressure on a nearby nerve.

Hamate Bone

Alternate name; see *Hamate*.

Hamman-Rich Syndrome

An acute, fulminant idiopathic interstitial pneumonia characterized by sudden onset of cough, rapidly progressive dyspnea, hypoxemic respiratory failure, and diffuse alveolar damage on lung biopsy in the absence of a known cause or preexisting lung disease.

Alternate Names:
Acute Interstitial Pneumonia; AIP

Hamman Sign

A crunching or clicking noise heard with a stethoscope over the chest in time with the heartbeat, caused by air trapped in the center of the chest.

Hamman's Sign

Alternate spelling; see *Hamman Sign*.

Hammer

The common name for the malleus, one of the three small bones of the middle ear.

Hammer Toe

A deformity in which a lesser toe bends downward at its middle joint and may press against the shoe. It can cause pain, stiffness, corns, or calluses and may be flexible at first or become fixed.

Hammertoe

Alternate spelling; see *Hammer Toe*.

Hammer Toe Repair

Surgery to correct a fixed or painful flexion deformity of a lesser toe, using soft-tissue release, tendon balancing, bone correction, or temporary fixation as indicated.

Hammertoes

Plural form; see *Hammer Toe*.

Hampton Hump

A wedge-shaped opacity next to the pleura on a chest X-ray, classically associated with pulmonary infarction from a pulmonary embolism. It is not specific enough to confirm a clot by itself.

Hampton Line

A historical X-ray sign described as a thin line across the neck of a stomach ulcer on a barium study. It was thought to favor a benign ulcer, but the sign is rarely used today and cannot reliably rule out cancer.

Alternate Names:
Hampton's Radiolucent Line; Peptic Hampton Line

Hampton's Hump

Alternate spelling; see *Hampton Hump*.

Hamstring

One of three muscles forming the posterior compartment of the thigh: semitendinosus, semimembranosus, and biceps femoris (long and short heads). Common origin: ischial tuberosity (except short head of biceps femoris which originates from the linea aspera of the femur).

Hamstring Injury

A strain or tear of one or more muscles or tendons at the back of the thigh.

Hamstring Muscles

The muscles at the back of the thigh. They bend the knee and help move the hip, especially during walking, running, and jumping. A sudden stretch or forceful contraction can strain or tear them.

Hamstring Strain

Alternate name; see *Hamstring Injury*.

Hand

The part of the upper limb beyond the wrist, containing the palm, fingers, bones, joints, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels used for grasping and sensation.

Hand-Arm Vibration Syndrome

An occupational disorder from prolonged exposure to vibrating tools, causing numbness, tingling, reduced grip, and episodic whitening of the fingers from vascular spasm.

Hand Deformity

An abnormal shape, alignment, or loss of motion of the hand or fingers caused by congenital difference, trauma, arthritis, nerve dysfunction, tendon disease, or other conditions.

H And E Staining

A standard laboratory stain using hematoxylin and eosin to show cell nuclei, cytoplasm, and tissue structure under a microscope. It is widely used to examine biopsies and identify inflammation, infection, or tumors.

Alternate Names:
H & E; H&E

Hand Foot And Mouth Disease

A contagious viral illness, most common in young children but possible at any age. It causes fever, painful mouth sores, and a rash or small blisters on the hands and feet, sometimes the buttocks. It spreads through saliva and mucus, blister fluid, stool, and contaminated surfaces. Most people recover in 7 to 10 days.

Hand-Foot-And-Mouth Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Hand Foot And Mouth Disease*.

Hand-Foot-And-Mouth Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Hand Foot And Mouth Disease*.

Hand-Foot-Mouth Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Hand Foot And Mouth Disease*.

Hand-Foot Syndrome

A dose-limiting toxic cutaneous reaction triggered by certain systemic antineoplastic and targeted chemotherapy agents (notably capecitabine, 5-fluorouracil, pegylated liposomal doxorubicin, cytarabine, and multi-kinase inhibitors like sorafenib and sunitinib). It is characterized by progressive bilateral burning dysesthesia, tingling, painful symmetric erythema, swelling, and subsequent blistering or desquamation primarily localized to the friction-bearing pressure areas of the palms and soles.

Alternate Names:
Palmar-Plantar Erythrodysesthesia; PPE; Chemotherapy-Induced Acral Erythema; Burgdorf Reaction

H And H

Abbreviation for hemoglobin and hematocrit, two blood measurements commonly used to assess red-blood-cell levels and anemia.

Hand-Held Retractor

A handheld surgical instrument used to hold tissue or an organ away from the operative field.

Alternate Names:
Manual Retractor; Handheld Retractor

Hand Hygiene

Cleaning the hands with soap and water or an alcohol-based hand rub to remove or kill germs. In health care, it is performed before and after patient contact, after touching body fluids, and when hands are visibly dirty.

Hand Infections

Infections involving the skin, tendon sheaths, joints, bones, or deep spaces of the hand. Pain, swelling, redness, impaired movement, fever, or a flexed finger can indicate deep or rapidly progressing infection.

Handling Sharps And Needles

Handling sharps and needles means using, passing, disposing of, and storing sharp medical instruments safely to prevent needlestick injuries and infection transmission.

Hand Microsurgery

Specialized hand surgery performed with magnification and fine instruments to repair or reconstruct

small blood vessels, nerves, and other delicate tissues. It may be used for complex injuries, replantation, and restoration of blood flow to a threatened digit or hand.

Hand of Benediction

An abnormal hand posture observed when a patient attempts to make a fist, resulting in extension of the index and middle fingers with flexion of the fourth and fifth fingers. It occurs due to proximal median nerve injury, which paralyses the flexor digitorum superficialis and the lateral half of the flexor digitorum profundus.

Alternate Names:
Benediction Sign; Preacher's Hand

Hand Or Foot Spasms

Sudden, involuntary tightening of muscles in a hand or foot. Causes include overuse, dehydration, abnormal calcium or other salts, nerve disease, medicines, and reduced blood flow; repeated or painful spasms need assessment.

H And P

Abbreviation for a patient's history and physical examination. The history covers symptoms, past health, medicines, and relevant background; the examination checks the body for signs of illness.

Hand Pain

Pain or discomfort in the hand, fingers, or wrist caused by injury, arthritis, nerve compression, tendon problems, infection, or other conditions. Sudden severe pain, deformity, numbness, or loss of circulation can indicate serious injury or impaired blood flow.

Hand Prolapse

A fetal hand or arm lying beside or below the part leading into the birth canal. It can obstruct labor and may reduce blood flow to the limb.

Hand-Schuller-Christian Disease

A multifocal, chronic form of Langerhans cell histiocytosis occurring predominantly in young children, classically defined by the clinical triad of multifocal lytic bone lesions ('punched-out' skull defects), diabetes insipidus, and exophthalmos.

Alternate Names:
Multifocal Unisystem LCH; Schuller-Christian Triad

Hand-SchüLler-Christian Disease

Hand-Schüller-Christian disease is an older name for a multisystem form of Langerhans cell histiocytosis, often involving bone, skin, and the pituitary gland.

Handwashing

Cleaning the hands with soap and water to remove dirt and germs. It is one method of hand hygiene; alcohol-based hand rub is another.

Hand X-Ray

Radiographic imaging of the hand used to evaluate fractures, dislocations, arthritis, infection, tumors, bone age, and other abnormalities of the bones and joints.

HANE

Historical abbreviation for hereditary angioneurotic edema, an older name for hereditary angioedema; see *Hereditary Angioedema*.

Hanging And Strangulation Signs

Injuries or other findings caused by pressure around the neck that restricts breathing or blood flow. Findings may include neck marks, swelling, voice changes, trouble swallowing, breathing difficulty, confusion, or loss of consciousness; internal injury can be serious even without visible marks.

Hanging Injuries and Strangulation

Injuries caused by constriction of the neck or suspension of the body, with potential airway, vascular, neurologic, and cervical-spine damage. Serious internal injury may occur even when external findings are limited.

Hangman Fracture

A traumatic bilateral fracture passing through the neural arch, pedicles, or pars interarticularis of the second cervical vertebra (axis, C2), classically

caused by sudden violent hyperextension and axial loading or distraction of the cervical spine.

Alternate Names:
Traumatic Spondylolisthesis of the Axis

Hangman's Fracture

Alternate spelling; see *Hangman Fracture*.

Hang-Nail

A small torn flap of skin beside a fingernail or toenail, often caused by dryness or trauma and vulnerable to local infection if torn or contaminated.

Hangover

A group of symptoms after alcohol use, such as headache, nausea, thirst, fatigue, dizziness, and sensitivity to light; symptoms reflect effects of alcohol and its metabolites, dehydration, sleep disruption, and inflammation.

Hansen Disease

A long-lasting infection caused by Mycobacterium leprae that mainly affects the skin and peripheral nerves. Pale or reddish numb patches, weakness, and eye problems may occur; multidrug antibiotics cure infection and prevent disability.

Alternate Names:
Leprosy; Hanseniasis; Mycobacterium Leprae Infection

Hantavirus

A group of viruses spread mainly by breathing dust contaminated with infected rodent urine, droppings, or nesting material. They can cause severe lung disease or a fever that damages the kidneys.

Hantavirus Cardiopulmonary Syndrome

Another name for hantavirus pulmonary syndrome, a severe hantavirus infection that can progress from fever and muscle aches to fluid in the lungs, breathing failure, and shock.

Hantavirus Cardiopulmonary Syndrome (HCPS)

Alternate name; see *Hantavirus Cardiopulmonary Syndrome*.

Hantavirus Infection

A zoonotic viral infection acquired mainly through inhalation of contaminated rodent excreta. It may cause hemorrhagic fever with renal syndrome or hantavirus pulmonary syndrome, which can progress rapidly to respiratory failure.

Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome

A severe lung infection acquired mainly by inhaling dust contaminated with infected rodent urine, droppings, or nesting material. Fever, muscle aches, headache, and stomach symptoms can rapidly progress to fluid-filled lungs and respiratory failure.

Alternate Names:
HPS; HCPS

Haploid

Having one complete set of chromosomes, as in a human sperm or egg. Haploid cells contain half the chromosome number of most body cells and restore the full number when they join during fertilization.

Haploidentical Donor

A donor who shares one human leukocyte antigen haplotype with the recipient, commonly used for selected hematopoietic stem-cell or organ transplantation when a fully matched donor is unavailable.

Haploidy

The state of having one complete set of chromosomes, as in human gametes; haploid cells contain 23 chromosomes.

Haploinsufficiency

A genetic state in which one functional copy of a gene does not produce enough gene product for normal function, so loss or inactivation of the other copy can cause disease.

Haplotype

A group of nearby gene versions inherited together on one chromosome. Haplotype information can help study inherited disease risk, identify tissue

donors, and trace how genetic traits are passed through families.

Hapten

A hapten is a small molecule that is not immunogenic by itself but can trigger an immune response after binding to a larger carrier protein, as in some drug allergies.

Haptoglobin

A blood protein made mainly by the liver that binds free hemoglobin released when red blood cells break down. Low levels can support evaluation of hemolysis, but liver disease and inflammation also affect the result.

Haptoglobin Analyses

Alternate name; see *Haptoglobin Blood Test*.

Haptoglobin Blood Test

A blood test measuring haptoglobin, a protein that binds free hemoglobin. A low result can support evaluation of red-cell breakdown but may also occur with reduced liver production.

Haptoglobin Decreased

A low blood haptoglobin result, commonly caused by intravascular red-cell destruction, reduced hepatic production, or severe liver disease; it is interpreted with hemoglobin, bilirubin, reticulocytes, and a blood smear.

Hardness of Skin

Alternate name; see *Skin Induration*.

Hardness (Thickening) of Skin

Alternate name; see *Skin Induration*.

Hard Palate

The bony, mucosa-covered front portion of the roof of the mouth that separates the oral and nasal cavities and provides a surface for chewing and speech.

Harlequin Color Change

A temporary, harmless change in a newborn's skin color in which one side becomes red while the other remains pale. It often appears when the baby lies on one side and usually fades within minutes.

Harlequin Foetus

Older term; see *Harlequin Ichthyosis*.

Harlequin Ichthyosis

A rare severe inherited skin disorder in which newborns have thick plates of skin separated by deep cracks. It can impair temperature control, movement, feeding, breathing, and protection from infection and requires intensive neonatal care.

Harmless Murmur

An innocent or physiologic heart murmur produced by normal blood flow without structural heart disease; it is diagnosed only after appropriate clinical assessment.

Harm Reduction

Evidence-based strategies that decrease health, social, and legal harms associated with substance use without requiring immediate abstinence. Examples include naloxone access, sterile injecting equipment, drug-checking where available, safer-use education, and linkage to treatment.

Harm Reduction Therapy

Care that aims to reduce illness, injury, infection, overdose, and other harms related to substance use. It can include safer-use services and support for treatment, including treatment for substance-use disorders.

Alternate Names:
Risk Mitigation Strategy

Harrison's Sulcus

Harrison's sulcus is a horizontal groove along the lower chest wall caused by inward pulling of the ribs, classically in long-standing childhood breathing difficulty.

Harseness of Voice

Alternate name; see *Hoarseness*.

Hartmann Pouch

An anatomical outpouching or dilatation of the inferior wall of the gallbladder neck adjacent to the junction with the cystic duct; gallstone impaction here may cause acute calculous cholecystitis or compress the adjacent common hepatic duct (Mirizzi syndrome).

Alternate Names:
Infundibulum of the Gallbladder

Hartmann Procedure

An operation that removes the diseased lower colon, brings the remaining colon through the abdominal wall as a colostomy, and closes the downstream bowel. It is often used when infection, blockage, perforation, or severe illness makes immediate reconnection unsafe.

Hartnup Disease

A rare inherited problem absorbing and reusing certain amino acids. It may cause a sun-sensitive rash, poor coordination, or mood and thinking changes, although some people have no symptoms.

Hartnup Disorder

An inherited disorder of neutral amino-acid transport that can cause pellagra-like skin changes, neurologic symptoms, or no symptoms.

HAS-BLED Score

A score estimating bleeding risk in a person with atrial fibrillation who may need a blood thinner. It considers high blood pressure, kidney or liver disease, previous stroke or bleeding, unstable clotting results, age, medicines, and alcohol; a high score identifies risk factors associated with bleeding.

Alternate Names:
HAS-BLED; Anticoagulant Bleeding Risk Index

Hashimoto Disease

Alternate name; see *Hashimoto Thyroiditis*.

Hashimoto Encephalopathy

A proposed, uncommon autoimmune encephalopathy reported in people with thyroid autoimmunity. It may involve confusion, seizures, abnormal movements, or stroke-like episodes. The relationship to thyroid disease remains uncertain, and thyroid antibodies alone do not establish the diagnosis; diagnosis depends on excluding other causes of encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Steroid-Responsive Encephalopathy Associated with Autoimmune Thyroiditis; SREAT

Hashimoto's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Hashimoto Thyroiditis*.

Hashimoto's Thyroiditis

Alternate spelling; see *Hashimoto Thyroiditis*.

Hashimoto Thyroiditis

An autoimmune disorder in which immune-mediated inflammation gradually damages the thyroid gland and may cause hypothyroidism. The gland may be enlarged or atrophic, and thyroid autoantibodies are often present.

Hashish

A concentrated form of cannabis made from resin of the cannabis plant. It contains cannabinoids that can impair memory, coordination, and judgment and may cause anxiety, dependence, or psychosis in susceptible people.

Hashitoxicosis

A temporary period of excess thyroid hormone caused by release of stored hormone during Hashimoto thyroiditis.

Hassall Corpuscles

Rounded, layered structures in the thymus medulla, made of thymic epithelial cells and associated with the development of immune tolerance.

Alternate Names:
Thymic Corpuscles; Hassall's Bodies

Hassall's Corpuscles

Alternate spelling; see *Hassall Corpuscles*.

Haustra

The series of small pouches along the outside of the large intestine. They form as the bowel muscles contract and help the colon mix and move its contents.

Haverhill Fever

Rat-bite fever acquired by swallowing food or drink contaminated with *Streptobacillus moniliformis*. It may cause fever, vomiting, headache, muscle or joint pain, and a rash.

Haversian Canal

A central longitudinal microscopic channel running through the core of each osteon (Haversian system) in compact cortical bone, carrying neurovascular structures (capillaries, postcapillary venules, and unmyelinated nerve fibers) to supply osteocytes embedded within surrounding concentric lamellae.

Alternate Names:
Central Canal of Bone

Hawkins Test

A physical examination maneuver used to identify subacromial shoulder impingement; the examiner flexes the patient's arm and elbow to 90 degrees and forcefully performs internal rotation of the humerus, compressing the supraspinatus tendon against the coracoacromial ligament.

Alternate Names:
Hawkins-Kennedy Impingement Test; Hawkins Sign

Hay Fever

A common name for seasonal allergic rhinitis, an allergic response to airborne outdoor plant pollens and mold spores that causes sneezing, a blocked or runny nose, an itchy palate, and watery, irritated eyes. See also *Seasonal Allergies*.

Alternate Names:
Seasonal Allergies; Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis; Pollinosis

Hazardous Materials

Substances that can cause injury, poisoning, fire, radiation exposure, or environmental harm; safe handling requires labeling, protective equipment, exposure control, and emergency procedures.

Hazardous Substance

A chemical, biological agent, or other material that can harm health through swallowing, inhalation, skin contact, injection, radiation, or environmental exposure. Risk depends on its properties, amount, route, and duration of exposure.

Hb

Hemoglobin, the iron-containing protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen and contributes to carbon-dioxide transport and blood's acid–base buffering.

HbA1c

Abbreviation; see *Hemoglobin A1c*.

HCG

Human chorionic gonadotropin is a hormone produced mainly during pregnancy; its measurement is used in pregnancy testing and evaluation of selected tumors.

HCG In Urine

A urine test detecting human chorionic gonadotropin, commonly used as a pregnancy test; accuracy depends on timing, urine concentration, and test performance.

Hct

The percentage of blood volume occupied by red blood cells, measured as part of a complete blood count.

HCV-Associated Rheumatic Disease

Joint, muscle, blood-vessel, or autoimmune problems associated with hepatitis C virus infection. Possible manifestations include joint pain or inflammation, mixed cryoglobulinemia, vasculitis, fatigue, or muscle symptoms.

HCV PCR

A polymerase chain reaction test that detects or measures hepatitis C virus RNA in blood, helping identify active infection and monitor treatment response.

HD

Abbreviation; see *Huntington Disease*.

HDL

High-density lipoprotein, a class of particles that transports cholesterol and other lipids in the blood. HDL concentration is one component of cardiovascular risk assessment and does not by itself indicate an individual's overall cardiovascular risk.

HDL Cholesterol

Cholesterol carried in high-density lipoprotein particles; HDL participates in transporting cholesterol from tissues toward the liver, but its concentration alone does not determine cardiovascular risk.

HDL Test

A blood test measuring high-density lipoprotein cholesterol, which is used with the rest of the lipid profile to assess cardiovascular risk.

HDR Syndrome

A genetic disorder characterized by hypoparathyroidism, sensorineural deafness, and renal dysplasia or other kidney abnormalities, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *GATA3*.

Head

The body region containing the brain, eyes, ears, nose, mouth, skull, and face, connected to the trunk by the neck and supplied by major cranial nerves and vessels.

Headache

Pain or discomfort in the head, scalp, or upper neck. Primary headaches include migraine and tension headache; secondary headaches result from another problem such as infection, injury, bleeding, very high blood pressure, or a brain disorder.

Headache and Migraine

Combined topic; see *Headache* and *Migraine*.

Headache Medicine

A medical subspecialty focused on headache and facial-pain disorders. It includes migraine, tension-type headache, cluster headache, and secondary headaches caused by another condition, with attention to their neurologic features, patterns, and effects on daily function.

Headache Red Flags

Features that raise concern for a secondary cause of headache, such as sudden severe onset, fever with neck stiffness, a new neurologic deficit, papilledema, a new headache after age 50, cancer or immune suppression, or a headache that changes with posture. These findings guide assessment but do not identify a cause by themselves.

Alternate Names:
Headache Warning Signs; Red Flag Headaches; Danger Signs in Headache

Headaches/Migraines

Alternate consumer label for headache disorders, especially *Migraine*; recurrent or new severe headaches can have primary or secondary causes.

Head And Face Reconstruction

Reconstructive surgery to restore the form or function of the skull, face, or associated soft tissues after trauma, cancer treatment, congenital difference, or other disease.

Head And Neck Cancer

Cancer arising in areas such as the mouth, throat, voice box, nasal cavity, or salivary glands. Most are squamous-cell cancers. Tobacco and alcohol are major risk factors; human papillomavirus is associated with some cancers of the throat.

Head And Neck Oncologic Surgery

Surgical treatment of cancers of the oral cavity, throat, larynx, nose, sinuses, salivary glands, or neck lymph nodes. Procedures may remove the tu-

mor, treat involved lymph nodes, and reconstruct affected tissues while preserving breathing, swallowing, speech, and appearance when possible.

Alternate Names:
Head and Neck Surgical Oncology; Maxillofacial Oncologic Surgery

Head Circumference

The measurement around the largest part of a baby's or child's head, taken above the eyebrows and ears. It is plotted over time to assess brain growth; unusually small, large, or rapidly changing measurements may need evaluation.

Head CT Scan

Computed tomography of the head using x-rays and computer reconstruction to evaluate the brain, skull, bleeding, stroke, tumors, trauma, and other abnormalities.

Head Impulse Test

A bedside test of the reflex that keeps vision steady when the head moves. The examiner turns the head quickly while the person looks at a target; a brief eye movement to regain the target can indicate reduced balance-organ function on that side.

Alternate Names:
Halmagyi-Curthoys Test

Head Injury

Damage to the scalp, skull, or brain caused by a blow, fall, collision, or penetrating object. It may cause a wound, skull fracture, concussion, or bleeding inside the skull. The effects range from a minor scalp injury to life-threatening brain damage.

Head Injury First Aid

Initial assessment and care after a head injury, including evaluation for brain, skull, and neck injury. Confusion, repeated vomiting, seizure, weakness, or loss of consciousness may indicate serious injury.

Alternate Names:
Cranial Trauma First Aid; Head Trauma Immediate Care

Head Lice

Infestation of the scalp by the insect *Pediculus humanus capitis*. It may cause itching, and small eggs called nits may be attached to hair near the scalp. Lice spread mainly through close head-to-head contact, not from poor hygiene.

Head-Lice

Alternate spelling; see *Head Lice*.

Head Movement

Motion of the head produced mainly by the cervical spine and neck muscles, including flexion, extension, rotation, and side bending; pain or restricted movement may indicate injury or disease.

Head MRI

Magnetic resonance imaging of the head using a magnetic field and radio waves to produce detailed images of the brain, cranial nerves, blood vessels, and surrounding structures.

Head-nodding

Repeated up-and-down movement of the head. This describes an observed movement rather than a diagnosis; it may be voluntary or involuntary, and its rhythm, triggers, and associated findings help distinguish a tremor, tic, seizure-related movement, or other cause.

Head Of The Epididymis

The upper part of the epididymis, connected to the testis by small ducts and receiving newly made sperm.

Head Thrust Test

Alternate name; see *Head Impulse Test*.

Head Trauma

Alternate name; see *Head Injury*.

Healing

The body's process of repairing damaged tissue. It usually involves stopping bleeding, reducing inflammation, forming new tissue, and remodeling a scar;

healing may be delayed by infection, poor blood flow, diabetes, or inadequate nutrition.

Health Anxiety Disorder

Excessive worry about having or developing a serious illness, often despite reassurance or limited medical findings. It can cause repeated checking or health-care visits and is treated with supportive care and evidence-based psychological therapy.

Health Behavior

An action or pattern of action that affects health, such as eating, physical activity, tobacco use, alcohol use, sexual practices, or taking medicines.

Health Behavior Change

Modification of behaviors that affect health, such as tobacco use, diet, physical activity, and adherence to treatment.

Health Behavior Motivation

Factors that influence initiation and maintenance of health-related behaviors, including adherence, physical activity, and smoking cessation.

Health Care

The prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and ongoing support provided to maintain or improve health, delivered by professionals, institutions, public-health systems, and informal caregivers.

Health Care Agents

People legally chosen to make healthcare decisions for someone who cannot make or communicate them. Their authority and responsibilities depend on local law and the document that appoints them.

Healthcare Associated Infection

An infection acquired while receiving healthcare or as a result of a medical procedure. It may occur in hospitals, clinics, nursing facilities, or at home and can involve a wound, urinary tract, lungs, bloodstream, or other site.

Health Care Facility

A place where health services are delivered, such as a clinic, hospital, laboratory, nursing facility, or rehabilitation center; its services and level of care determine appropriate referrals.

Health Care Personnel

People who provide or support health services, including clinicians, nurses, therapists, technicians, and aides.

Healthcare Provider

A healthcare professional or organization that provides medical care, such as a physician, nurse, therapist, or clinic.

Health Care Proxy

A person designated to make healthcare decisions for someone who cannot make or communicate those decisions. The appointment may be recorded in an advance directive or other legal document.

Healthcare Proxy

Alternate spelling; see *Health Care Proxy*.

Health Checkup

A preventive visit to review a person's health risks and update age- or risk-based care. It may include blood-pressure measurement, review of medicines and vaccinations, and screening for conditions such as high cholesterol, diabetes, or cancer.

Health Disparities

Differences in health outcomes or access to care among groups, often associated with social, economic, environmental, geographic, or structural factors.

Health Disparity

Singular form; see *Health Disparities*.

Health Education

The process of giving people understandable information and skills to prevent illness, recognize symptoms, use treatment safely, and make informed

health decisions.

Health Inequity

A systematic, avoidable, and unjust difference in health or access to health resources between social groups. It differs from health variation that is not preventable or not linked to unfair social conditions.

Health Information Technology

The use of computers and digital systems to collect, store, exchange, protect, and use health information. Examples include electronic records, telemedicine, patient portals, decision-support tools, and remote monitoring; safe systems protect privacy and support accurate care.

Health Literacy

The ability to find, understand, judge, and use health information and services to make appropriate decisions. It includes communicating with clinicians, understanding instructions and medicine labels, and identifying when care may be needed; clear communication by healthcare staff also improves health literacy.

Health Maintenance Organization

A health-insurance arrangement that usually uses a network of clinicians and requires a primary-care clinician to coordinate specialist care. Coverage rules, referrals, costs, and services vary by plan.

Health Promotion

Actions that help people improve or protect their health and prevent illness. They may include vaccination, healthy eating, physical activity, sleep, screening, safer environments, social connection, and avoiding tobacco. Effective approaches vary with age, abilities, culture, risks, and preferences.

Health-Related QoL

A person's physical, emotional, social, and daily functioning as affected by health and illness. It reflects the patient's experience and is assessed separately from laboratory results or survival.

Health Risk

The likelihood that a behavior, exposure, condition, or other factor will cause harm to health, considered together with the severity and timing of possible harm.

Health Risks Of Alcohol Use

Alcohol use can increase the risk of liver disease, several cancers, high blood pressure, injuries, dependence, and problems affecting mental health and relationships.

Health Surveillance

The ongoing collection and analysis of health data to identify patterns, monitor disease, and guide public-health action.

Health Survey

A structured set of questions used to collect information about health, symptoms, behaviors, healthcare use, or population needs.

Healthy Aging

Developing and maintaining the physical and mental abilities that support well-being and independence in later life. It is influenced by health conditions, activity, nutrition, relationships, environment, and access to care.

Hearing

The ability to detect and understand sound. Sound vibrations are converted into nerve signals in the inner ear and interpreted by the brain. Hearing loss may result from the outer or middle ear, inner ear, hearing nerve, or brain pathways.

Hearing Aid

A small electronic device worn in or behind the ear that makes sounds louder or clearer for someone with hearing loss. It contains a microphone, processor, and speaker and is fitted and adjusted according to hearing-test results.

Hearing Aids And Devices

Alternate name; see *Hearing Aid*.

Hearing Disorder

A condition that reduces or distorts hearing through disease of the outer or middle ear, cochlea, auditory nerve, or central pathways; audiometry and examination help distinguish conductive from sensorineural loss.

Hearing Impairment

Partial or complete reduction in the ability to detect or understand sound. It may be conductive, sensorineural, or mixed and can result from congenital disorders, infection, noise, ototoxic injury, trauma, ageing, or disease of the ear or auditory pathways.

Hearing Loss

Reduced ability to hear. Conductive loss results from a problem in the outer or middle ear; sensorineural loss results from damage to the inner ear or hearing nerve; mixed loss has both types. Causes include aging, noise, infection, injury, and some medicines.

Hearing Loss And Music

Difficulty hearing or distinguishing musical sounds because of reduced hearing or changes in how the brain processes sound. Music may seem quieter, distorted, or lacking certain pitches.

Hearing Loss: Sudden Deafness

A rapid sensorineural hearing loss, usually developing over hours to a few days, that may affect one or both ears. It is an otologic emergency; early hearing testing and treatment may improve recovery.

Hearing Screening

A quick test used to identify possible hearing loss before symptoms are obvious. Newborns are commonly screened before leaving hospital; abnormal results are followed by repeat testing and a full hearing assessment and do not by themselves confirm permanent loss.

Hearing Test

An audiologic assessment that measures hearing thresholds and speech perception across frequencies to identify conductive, sensorineural, or mixed hearing loss.

Heart

A four-chambered muscular pump (two atria, two ventricles) located in the mediastinum, responsible for circulating blood throughout the body.

Heart And Vascular Services

Heart and vascular services include prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of diseases affecting the heart and blood vessels.

Heart Aneurysm

A localized bulging or outpouching of a weakened heart wall, often after myocardial infarction or from cardiomyopathy, that can impair contraction or form clots and arrhythmias.

Heart Arrhythmia

An abnormal heart rate or rhythm caused by altered electrical activity in the heart. At rest, the adult heart usually beats regularly at about 60–100 times per minute; an arrhythmia may make it beat too fast, too slowly, or irregularly.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Dysrhythmias

Heart Assist Device

A mechanical device that supports the pumping function of the heart, such as a ventricular assist device, in selected patients with severe heart failure.

Heart Attack

A heart attack (myocardial infarction) occurs when blood flow to part of the heart muscle is suddenly reduced or blocked, usually because a blood clot forms in a heart artery. The reduced oxygen supply can injure or kill heart muscle. Symptoms may include chest discomfort, shortness of breath, sweating, or nausea, but they vary and may be mild or absent. A suspected heart attack is a medical emergency.

Heart Attack First Aid

Initial response to a suspected heart attack, centered on rapid emergency assessment and recognition of

cardiac arrest. Aspirin may be used in some settings when appropriate and not contraindicated.

Heart Attack Prevention

Heart-attack prevention targets blood pressure, atherogenic cholesterol, diabetes, tobacco exposure, diet, physical activity, weight, sleep, and adherence to prescribed medicines. Risk-based preventive treatment is more effective than relying on one supplement or symptom.

Heartbeat

One complete contraction and relaxation of the heart, which moves blood through the lungs and the rest of the body. The rate and rhythm can be assessed by feeling a pulse or recording the heart's electrical activity.

Heart Block

A delay or interruption in the electrical signal traveling from the heart's upper chambers to its lower chambers. It may cause a slow or irregular heartbeat, dizziness, fainting, or no symptoms.

Heartburn

A burning feeling behind the breastbone caused by stomach contents flowing back into the esophagus. It may be accompanied by a sour taste or regurgitation and is not usually caused by the heart. Frequent symptoms may indicate reflux disease.

Heartburn/GERD

Alternate name; see *Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease*.

Heart Bypass Surgery

Coronary artery bypass grafting creates new routes around blocked coronary arteries using graft vessels to improve myocardial blood flow and relieve ischemic symptoms or reduce selected risks.

Heart Catheterization

A procedure in which a catheter is passed through a blood vessel into the heart to measure pressures, assess coronary arteries, inject contrast, obtain samples, or perform treatment.

Heart Chambers

The four spaces inside the heart: the right and left atria, which receive blood, and the right and left ventricles, which pump blood out.

Heart Contraction

The squeezing of heart muscle that pushes blood from the lower chambers to the lungs and the rest of the body. Electrical signals coordinate the heartbeat, and abnormal contraction can reduce blood flow or cause rhythm problems.

Heart CT Scan

Computed tomography of the heart and nearby structures, sometimes with ECG synchronization or contrast, used to evaluate coronary arteries, cardiac anatomy, calcium, or selected masses.

Heart Defect

An abnormality of the heart or major blood vessels. It may be present from birth or develop later and can affect blood flow, heart rhythm, valve function, or pumping ability.

Heart Disease

A broad term for conditions affecting the heart, including coronary artery disease, heart failure, abnormal rhythms, valve disease, and congenital defects. Related blood-vessel conditions are usually described as vascular disease. Symptoms vary with the condition and may include chest pain, breathlessness, palpitations, or swelling.

Heart Disease And Depression

Depression may coexist with heart disease and is associated with reduced quality of life and poorer cardiovascular outcomes. Each condition can affect the course and management of the other.

Heart Disease And Intimacy

Heart disease and some treatments can affect sexual function, desire, and confidence. The effects vary with the condition, its severity, and the treatment.

Heart Disease And Women

Heart disease affects women as well as men. Heart attack symptoms in women may include chest discomfort, shortness of breath, nausea, fatigue, or jaw, back, or arm discomfort; chest discomfort remains common.

Heart Failure

A chronic condition that occurs when the heart muscle cannot pump blood effectively enough to supply the body's cells with adequate oxygen and nutrients. It can develop after a heart attack, long-standing high blood pressure, or valve disease. When the weakened or stiff heart cannot keep up with the body's circulation, fluid backs up into the lungs and body tissues, leading to shortness of breath (especially when lying flat or during exercise), persistent fatigue, and swelling in the legs, ankles, and feet.

Alternate Names:
Congestive Heart Failure; CHF; Cardiac Failure

Heart Failure Due To Valvular Heart Disease

Heart failure caused by narrowing or leakage of one or more heart valves. The valve problem can strain the heart or limit blood flow, causing breathlessness, tiredness, reduced ability to exercise, or swelling. Assessment identifies the affected valve and how it affects heart function.

Heart Failure In Children

A condition in which a child's heart cannot pump or fill well enough to meet the body's needs. It may cause fast breathing, sweating or tiring during feeds, poor growth, swelling, or reduced activity.

Heart Failure Stages

A framework describing progression from risk without heart disease, to heart changes without symptoms, to heart failure with symptoms, and finally advanced disease with persistent symptoms. Stages help guide prevention and treatment and are different from scales that describe how limited a person feels during activity.

Heart Failure With Mildly Reduced Ejection Fraction

Heart failure in which the left ventricle pumps out a somewhat smaller-than-usual proportion of its blood, commonly about 41–49 percent. Symptoms may include breathlessness, tiredness, and fluid-related swelling.

Heart Failure With Preserved Ejection Fraction

Heart failure in which the left ventricular ejection fraction—the proportion of blood ejected with each beat—is at least 50

Alternate Names:
HFpEF

Heart Failure With Reduced Ejection Fraction

Heart failure with a left ventricular ejection fraction of 40% or less. It can cause breathlessness, tiredness, and swelling and may result from coronary artery disease, heart-muscle disease, high blood pressure, or valve disease.

Heart Injury

Damage to heart muscle or surrounding cardiac structures caused by trauma, ischemia, inflammation, toxins, or procedures; symptoms and tests depend on the injured tissue and severity.

Heartland Virus

A tick-borne virus associated with fever, fatigue, headache, muscle aches, diarrhea, and low white-cell or platelet counts. It can resemble ehrlichiosis and may be severe, especially in older or medically vulnerable people.

Heart-Lung Machine

A device that temporarily takes over the pumping and gas-exchange functions of the heart and lungs during selected cardiac operations.

Alternate Names:
Cardiopulmonary Bypass Pump

Heart MRI

Magnetic resonance imaging of the heart that eval-

uates cardiac structure, function, tissue characteristics, blood flow, and selected congenital, ischemic, inflammatory, or infiltrative disorders.

Heart Murmur

An extra or unusual sound heard when blood flows through the heart or nearby blood vessels. Some murmurs are harmless, while others result from a valve problem, heart defect, or altered blood flow.

Heart Murmurs

Plural form; see *Heart Murmur*.

Heart Muscle

The myocardium, the specialized cardiac muscle that contracts rhythmically to pump blood through the heart and circulation.

Heart Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the heart or its surrounding tissues. It may be benign or cancerous and can interfere with blood flow, heart rhythm, or pumping; evaluation uses imaging and sometimes biopsy.

Heart Pacemaker

A heart pacemaker is a device that sends electrical impulses to maintain an appropriate heartbeat when the heart's natural rhythm is too slow or unreliable.

Heart Palpitations

Alternate name; see *Palpitation*.

Heart PET Scan

Positron-emission tomography of the heart using a radiotracer to assess myocardial perfusion, metabolism, viability, inflammation, or selected cardiac masses.

Heart Rate

The number of heartbeats per minute. Resting rates vary with age, fitness, activity, illness, medicines, and emotion; a persistently very fast, slow, or irregular rate may need assessment.

Heart Rate Variability

The natural change in time between one heartbeat and the next. It reflects several influences on the heart's rhythm, including breathing, activity, sleep, and the nervous system.

Alternate Names:
HRV

Heart Rhythm

The rate and pattern of cardiac electrical activation and contraction, normally initiated by the sinoatrial node; abnormal rhythms include bradycardia, tachycardia, atrial fibrillation, and ventricular arrhythmias.

Heart Rhythm Disorders

Arrhythmias, in which the heart beats too fast, too slowly, or irregularly because of abnormal electrical impulse formation or conduction.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Arrhythmias; Dysrhythmias

Heart Septum

The muscular or membranous wall separating the right and left sides of the heart, including the atrial and ventricular septa; defects can permit abnormal blood flow between chambers.

Heart-Smart Substitutions

Food substitutions intended to reduce saturated fat, sodium, or refined grains, such as replacing butter with unsaturated oils or refined grains with whole grains.

Heart Sounds

The sounds made as the heart valves open and close during each heartbeat. The usual two sounds are called "lub-dub"; extra or unusual sounds may suggest a valve problem, heart failure, or another condition.

Heart Surgery

Surgical procedures performed on the heart or great vessels to treat structural or functional cardiac conditions. Common operations include coronary artery

bypass grafting (CABG), valve repair or replacement, and repair of congenital heart defects.

Heart Tamponade

A life-threatening condition in which fluid or blood builds up around the heart and prevents it from filling normally. It can cause breathlessness, faintness, low blood pressure, and shock; treatment usually involves urgent drainage of the fluid.

Heart Transplant

Replacement of a failing heart with a donor heart, followed by lifelong immunosuppression and surveillance for rejection, infection, coronary allograft disease, kidney injury, and medication complications.

Heart Transplantation

Alternate term; see *Heart Transplant*.

Heart Valve

A flap-like structure that directs one-way blood flow through the heart. The four valves are the tricuspid, pulmonary, mitral, and aortic valves.

Heart Valve Disease

Damage or abnormality of one or more of the heart's valves. A valve may become narrowed and restrict blood flow (stenosis), or may not close fully and allow blood to leak backward (regurgitation). Causes include age-related changes, a defect present at birth, rheumatic disease, and infection.

Heart Valve Disorder

Alternate name; see *Heart Valve Disease*.

Heart Valve Prosthesis

An artificial valve used to replace or repair a diseased heart valve. Mechanical valves are durable but usually require long-term blood-thinning medicine. Tissue valves may avoid lifelong blood thinners but can wear out and sometimes need another procedure.

Heart Valve Surgery

Repair or replacement of a diseased cardiac valve to correct severe narrowing or leakage and improve blood flow; choice of repair, mechanical valve, or tissue valve depends on anatomy and patient factors.

Alternate Names:
Heart Valve Repair Or Replacement

Heart Valve Replacement

A surgical or catheter-based procedure to excise a diseased, stenotic, or incompetent heart valve and replace it with a mechanical or bioprosthetic tissue valve; see *Heart Valve Surgery* and *Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement*.

Heart Ventricle

One of the two lower heart chambers that pumps blood to the lungs or systemic circulation; the right ventricle pumps to the pulmonary artery and the left to the aorta.

Heart Ventricles

Plural form; see *Heart Ventricle*.

Heat

Thermal energy that raises tissue or body temperature; excessive heat exposure can cause heat cramps, heat exhaustion, heatstroke, or thermal injury.

Heat Cramps

Painful, involuntary muscle spasms occurring during or after strenuous activity in heat, often associated with fluid and electrolyte loss. Confusion, fainting, or altered mental status suggests a more serious heat illness rather than uncomplicated heat cramps.

Heat Emergencies

Heat emergencies range from heat cramps and exhaustion to heat stroke, in which dangerous core-temperature elevation causes central nervous system dysfunction and organ injury.

Heat Exhaustion

A heat-related illness caused by losing too much water and salt through sweating. It may cause heavy sweating, weakness, dizziness, headache, nausea,

or fainting. Confusion, seizures, or very hot skin suggest heat stroke, a life-threatening illness.

Heat Intolerance

An abnormal inability to tolerate warm environments or increased body heat, often causing excessive sweating, flushing, fatigue, or dizziness. Common causes include hyperthyroidism, menopause, fever, medications, autonomic disorders, and dehydration.

Heat Pack

A device that applies warmth to the body surface to relieve some muscle pain or stiffness. Excessive heat or prolonged contact can cause burns.

Heat Prostration

Older term; see *Heat Exhaustion*.

Heat Rash

An itchy or prickly rash caused by blocked sweat ducts during hot, humid conditions. Small red bumps or clear vesicles often appear in skin folds or areas covered by clothing.

Heat Shock Protein

A stress-response protein that helps other proteins fold, avoid aggregation, and recover after heat, oxidative, infectious, or other cellular stress; some also influence immunity and cancer biology.

Heat Stress

The strain placed on the body when it cannot adequately lose heat, often during hot or humid conditions, exertion, or inadequate hydration. It can progress from heat cramps or exhaustion to life-threatening heat stroke.

Heat Stroke

A life-threatening heat-related illness with markedly elevated body temperature and altered mental status. It may cause confusion, seizures, loss of consciousness, and damage to multiple organs.

Heavy Menstrual Bleeding

Menstrual bleeding that is unusually heavy, prolonged, or disruptive to daily life. Causes include fibroids, adenomyosis, polyps, changes in ovulation, bleeding disorders, medicines, or other medical conditions. Ongoing blood loss may cause iron-deficiency anemia; bleeding during pregnancy is not menstrual bleeding and needs separate assessment.

Alternate Names:
Menorrhagia; Hypermenorrhea

Heavy Metal Poisoning

Illness caused by toxic exposure to metals or metalloids such as lead, mercury, arsenic, cadmium, or thallium. Lead and mercury can injure the brain and nerves, cadmium can damage the kidneys and lungs, and arsenic can affect the skin and internal organs. The effects depend on the substance, amount, route, and duration of exposure.

Heberden Node

A small, hard bony bump or swelling that develops on the finger joint closest to the fingernail (the distal joint). It is a classic physical sign of osteoarthritis, caused by the gradual breakdown of joint cartilage and subsequent bone spurs (osteophytes) forming around the joint edges. While often painless or only mildly tender when fully formed, these nodes can cause joint stiffness or crookedness in the fingers.

Alternate Names:
Heberden Nodes; Heberden's Node; Heberden's Nodes; Heberden Arthropathy

Heberden Nodes

Plural form; see *Heberden Node*.

Heberden's Node

Alternate form; see *Heberden Node*.

Heberden's Nodes

Alternate plural; see *Heberden Node*.

Hecht's Pneumonia

A rare, severe form of measles-related pneumonia, usually affecting people with weakened immunity.

It can cause rapidly worsening breathing problems and is treated in hospital with supportive care and management of complications.

Hedgehog Proteins

Signaling proteins that help guide the growth and organization of tissues before birth and during repair. Abnormal activity in this pathway can contribute to some birth differences and cancers.

Heel

The heel is the back and underside of the foot, formed mainly by the calcaneus and a cushioning fat pad.

Heel Fat Pad Syndrome

Pain caused by thinning, damage, or loss of spring in the cushioning fat pad beneath the heel. It often feels like a deep bruise in the center of the heel and may worsen with standing or walking on hard surfaces; see also *Plantar Fasciitis*.

Heel Pain

Pain beneath or around the heel, commonly caused by plantar fasciitis, Achilles tendinopathy, bursitis, stress fracture, nerve compression, or inflammatory arthritis.

Heel Spur

A bony growth arising from the heel bone, often associated with plantar-fascia strain. The spur itself may cause no symptoms; heel pain is more often related to surrounding soft-tissue inflammation.

Heel-to-Shin Test

A neurological test of lower limb coordination in which the patient places the heel of one foot on the opposite knee and slides it smoothly down the crest of the tibia to the ankle. Inability to maintain contact or an irregular, jerky trajectory indicates cerebellar ataxia or sensory ataxia.

Heerfordt Syndrome

A specific clinical presentation of acute sarcoidosis characterized by the classic tetrad of anterior uveitis, bilateral parotitis (parotid gland enlargement), low-grade pyrexia, and unilateral or bilateral lower motor neuron facial nerve (CN VII) palsy.

Alternate Names:
Uveoparotid Fever; Heerfordt-Waldenström Syndrome

Hegar's Dilators

Hegar's dilators are graduated metal instruments used to gently widen the cervix or other body openings during selected procedures.

Hegar's Sign

Softening of the lower part of the uterus, once used as an early sign of pregnancy. It is not specific and is not sufficient to confirm pregnancy without testing.

Height

The vertical distance from the base of a person to the top of the head, measured for growth assessment, nutritional evaluation, drug dosing, and calculation of body-mass index.

Heimlich Maneuver

A common name for abdominal thrusts used to relieve severe choking in a responsive person. First-aid techniques differ for adults, children, infants, and pregnant people; serious airway obstruction may require emergency treatment.

Heimlich Maneuver On Self

A self-administered abdominal-thrust technique sometimes used for severe choking when a person cannot breathe, speak, or cough effectively; severe obstruction can cause loss of consciousness or death.

Heimlich Manoeuvre

An emergency procedure for relieving upper airway obstruction caused by a foreign body (choking). The maneuver is performed on a conscious, choking adult who cannot speak, cough effectively, or breathe.

Heine-Medin Disease

An older name for polio, a viral infection that can

inflame the spinal cord and brain. It may cause fever and weakness and sometimes permanent paralysis; vaccination prevents most cases.

Heinz Bodies

Clumps of damaged hemoglobin inside red blood cells, usually formed after oxidative injury. They may occur in glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency or after exposure to certain medicines, chemicals, or infections.

Hejama

An Arabic term for cupping, a traditional practice in which suction is applied to the skin; wet cupping also involves superficial skin incisions and carries bleeding and infection risks.

Helcococcus

A genus of gram-positive cocci that can rarely cause opportunistic skin, wound, bone, or bloodstream infections.

Helcococcus Kunzii

A Gram-positive round bacterium usually found on skin that rarely causes opportunistic infection. Reported infections may involve wounds, blood, or implanted devices in people with serious illness or weakened defenses.

Helcococcus Pyogenes

A rarely encountered Gram-positive round bacterium that may cause opportunistic human infection. It has been found in wounds or blood, particularly in people with serious illness, chronic wounds, or weakened immunity.

Helicase

An enzyme that uses cellular energy to separate the paired strands of DNA or RNA. This allows genetic material to be copied, repaired, or read.

Helicobacter

A genus of spiral-shaped bacteria that colonize the stomach or intestine; some species cause ulcers, gastritis, or other disease.

Helicobacteraceae

A family of spiral-shaped bacteria that includes Helicobacter and related genera, many of which inhabit the digestive tract.

Helicobacter Cinaedi

A Helicobacter species that can cause bloodstream, skin, bone, joint, or other invasive infections, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Helicobacter Fennelliae

An intestinal Helicobacter species that rarely causes bloodstream or other opportunistic infection. Disease is more likely in people with weakened defenses, and diagnosis requires specialized laboratory identification.

Helicobacter Pylori

A gram-negative, spiral-shaped bacterium adapted to colonize the stomach. It can cause chronic gastritis, peptic ulcer disease, and increase the risk of gastric cancer and gastric MALT lymphoma.

Helicobacter Pylori-Associated Active Gastritis Pathology

Chronic active gastritis with lymphoplasmacytic inflammation, neutrophils in pits or surface epithelium, lymphoid aggregates, and curved organisms along the surface mucus or foveolar epithelium.

Helicobacter Pylori Eradication

Elimination of a stomach infection with *Helicobacter pylori* using a combination of medicines. The regimen is selected based on factors such as antibiotic resistance and past treatment. A follow-up test can confirm whether the infection has cleared.

Helicobacter Pylori Infection

Infection of the stomach by H. pylori, a spiral-shaped bacterium associated with chronic gastritis, peptic ulcer disease, gastric adenocarcinoma, and gastric MALT lymphoma. It is diagnosed with noninvasive or endoscopic testing and treated with combination eradication therapy.

Helicotrema

The narrow anatomical communication aperture located at the apex of the cochlea where the scala vestibuli meets and continues into the scala tympani, allowing pressure equilibration of perilymph between the two compartments.

Heliotherapy

Treatment using controlled exposure to sunlight or artificial ultraviolet light. It has been used for selected skin disorders, but excessive exposure can cause burns, premature aging, eye injury, and skin cancer.

Heliotrope Rash

Symmetric violaceous or dusky-red discoloration of the upper eyelids, sometimes extending around the eyes and accompanied by eyelid swelling. It is a characteristic skin finding of dermatomyositis and may occur even without muscle weakness; diagnosis depends on the overall clinical findings, not the rash alone.

Alternate Names:
Heliotrope Erythema; Dermatomyositis Eyelid Sign

Helium

A chemically inert gas used in respiratory mixtures, cryogenics, imaging, and laboratory applications; inhalation can displace oxygen and cause hypoxia despite its lack of direct toxicity.

Helix

The curved outer rim of the external ear. Its shape is formed by cartilage covered with skin; swelling, tenderness, or a skin change on the helix may follow injury, infection, sun damage, or other skin disease.

Heller Myotomy

A surgical procedure that cuts the muscles of the lower esophageal sphincter to relieve obstruction in achalasia, usually performed laparoscopically and often combined with an antireflux procedure.

Heller's Operation

A surgical procedure that cuts the lower esophageal muscle to relieve achalasia, usually with an antireflux procedure.

HELLP syndrome

A pregnancy-associated syndrome named for hemolysis, elevated liver enzymes, and low platelet count. It is a form of microangiopathic disease that may occur with preeclampsia and can involve upper-abdominal pain, nausea, headache, or high blood pressure.

Helminth

A medical term for a parasitic worm that lives in human or animal tissues or organs. The major types that cause human infections include roundworms (such as pinworms and hookworms), tapeworms, and flukes. Infections typically occur from swallowing worm eggs in contaminated food or water, walking barefoot on contaminated soil, or through insect bites, and can cause digestive symptoms, nutrient deficiencies, or organ irritation.

Alternate Names:
Helminths; Parasitic Worm

Helminthiasis

Infection or infestation caused by parasitic worms, including roundworms, tapeworms, and flukes. Symptoms vary by species and may include abdominal problems, anemia, cough, rash, malnutrition, or organ damage.

Alternate Names:
Worm Infestation; Helminthic Parasitosis

Helminths

Plural form; see *Helminth*.

HELPERR Mnemonic

A memory aid for managing shoulder dystocia during birth: call for help, consider an episiotomy, flex the birthing person's legs, apply suprapubic pressure, perform internal maneuvers, remove the baby's posterior arm, and roll to an all-fours position. It is used by trained obstetric staff.

Helper T Cell

A vital type of white blood cell (lymphocyte) that coordinates the body's adaptive immune system against infections. Also known as a CD4-positive T cell, it acts as an immune conductor: when it recognizes foreign antigens from viruses, bacteria, or other invaders, it releases chemical messengers (cytokines) that activate B cells to make antibodies and alert killer T cells and macrophages to destroy infected cells.

Alternate Names:
Helper T Cells; CD4+ T Cell; T-Helper Lymphocyte

Helper T Cells

Plural form; see *Helper T Cell*.

Helper Virus

A virus that supplies functions needed for another virus or defective viral genome to replicate.

Help Prevent Hospital Errors

Patient-safety practices intended to reduce preventable harm in hospitals, including accurate identification, medication reconciliation, clear communication, and timely reporting of clinical changes.

Hemagglutination Test

A test in which antibodies or other agents cause red blood cells to clump; the reaction can help detect antibodies, antigens, or selected infectious agents.

Hemagglutinin

A surface glycoprotein, especially on influenza viruses, that binds sialic-acid receptors and helps the virus attach to and enter host cells; it is a major target of protective antibodies.

Hemangioblastoma

A usually slow-growing tumor made of blood-vessel-forming cells, most often found in the cerebellum or spinal cord. It may cause headache, balance problems, or weakness and can be associated with von Hippel–Lindau disease.

Hemangioendothelioma

A rare tumor arising from cells that line blood vessels. Its behavior ranges from slow-growing to cancerous, depending on the subtype and location, so diagnosis requires tissue examination and specialist assessment.

Hemangioma

A benign tumor formed by an overgrowth of blood vessels. It can occur in the skin or an internal organ. Infantile hemangiomas usually appear in the first weeks of life, grow for a time, then gradually shrink. Some lesions once called hemangiomas are vascular malformations, not tumors. Depending on its size and location, a hemangioma can bleed, form sores, or affect nearby body parts.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Hemangioma

Hemangiopericytoma

A rare tumor formerly defined by branching "staghorn" vessels and perivascular cells; many lesions classified this way are now recognized as solitary fibrous tumors.

Hemangiosarcoma

A malignant tumor of vascular endothelial cells, an aggressive sarcoma that may arise in the skin, liver, or bone.

Hemarthrosis

Bleeding into a joint, most often the knee, causing rapid swelling, warmth, pain, and limited movement. Injury and bleeding disorders such as hemophilia are common causes; repeated episodes can damage cartilage and lead to long-term joint disease.

Hematemesis

Vomiting blood, either bright red or dark and granular like coffee grounds because stomach acid has altered the blood. It usually signals bleeding from the upper digestive tract, such as the esophagus, stomach, or duodenum, the first part of the small intestine. The bleeding can be life-threatening.

Hematidrosis

A very rare condition in which blood-tinged fluid appears through apparently intact skin or other surfaces, sometimes during extreme stress. The diagnosis requires careful examination to exclude injury, skin disease, bleeding disorders, or contamination.

Hematocele

A collection of blood around a testicle, usually after scrotal injury or surgery and sometimes from a tumor. It can cause a heavy, firm, painful swelling; ultrasound is needed to check the testicle and blood flow, and large collections may need surgery.

Alternate Names:
Scrotal Hematocele; Tunica Vaginalis Blood Collection

Hematochezia

Passing bright-red or maroon blood from the rectum. It often comes from the large intestine, rectum, or anus, but heavy bleeding higher in the digestive tract can look the same.

Hematocolpos

Accumulation of menstrual blood in the vagina, usually because an imperforate hymen or another obstructing anomaly prevents outflow; it may cause cyclic pelvic pain and a bulging vaginal membrane.

Hematocrit

The percentage of blood volume made up by red blood cells, also called packed cell volume. It is measured in a blood sample and is usually reported as part of a complete blood count. A low or high result can reflect changes in red-cell amount or in the fluid portion of blood and is interpreted with other findings.

Hematocrit Test

A laboratory measurement of the percentage of total blood volume occupied by red blood cells; see *Hematocrit* and *Complete Blood Count*.

Hematocytopenia

Alternate term; see *Cytopenia*.

Hematocyturia

Alternate term; see *Hematuria*.

Hematogenous

Spread through the bloodstream, as when infection, tumor cells, or embolic material travels from one body site to another.

Hematogenous Osteomyelitis

An invasive bone infection arising from bacteremic seeding of the vascular marrow spaces, classically affecting the metaphyses of long bones in growing children (due to slow sinusoidal capillary blood flow) and the vertebral bodies (spondylodiscitis) in older adults, most frequently caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*.

Hematologic Agents

Medicines or biologic therapies that act on blood cells, coagulation, marrow, or immune pathways, including agents used for anemia, thrombosis, leukemia, and lymphoma.

Hematological Disease

A disorder of blood cells, bone marrow, lymphatic tissue, or coagulation, including anemia, leukemia, lymphoma, bleeding disorders, and clotting disorders.

Hematologic Changes In Pregnancy

Pregnancy normally increases the fluid part of blood more than the red-cell mass, so blood counts may show mild dilutional anemia. White-cell counts also commonly rise, mainly because of more neutrophils. Normal ranges differ from those outside pregnancy.

Hematologic Malignancy

Alternate name; see *Blood Cancer*.

Hematologic Response

A measurable improvement or change in blood counts or marrow findings after treatment, such as recovery of neutrophils, platelets, or hemoglobin or reduction of malignant cells.

Hematologist

A physician who diagnoses and treats disorders of blood, bone marrow, lymph nodes, clotting, and hematologic cancers.

Hematology

The branch of medicine concerned with the study, diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of disorders of the blood and blood-forming organs (bone marrow, lymph nodes, spleen).

Hematology-Oncology

The medical specialty concerned with blood disorders and cancers, including anemia, leukemia, lymphoma, myeloma, and clotting disorders.

Hematoma

A collection of blood outside a blood vessel, usually after injury, surgery, or bleeding caused by illness or medicines. It may cause swelling and pain and can press on nearby nerves or organs.

Hematoma Evacuation

Surgical removal or drainage of a collection of blood to relieve pressure and prevent further tissue injury. Intracranial hematoma evacuation may use a burr hole, craniotomy, or craniectomy and is considered when bleeding causes neurologic deterioration, dangerous mass effect, or increased intracranial pressure.

Hematometra

Blood trapped inside the uterus because the normal outlet is blocked or too narrow. It can cause absent periods, monthly pelvic pain, and an enlarged tender uterus; the blockage may be present from birth or develop after scarring, surgery, infection, or radiation.

Hematometrocolpos

A buildup of menstrual blood in the uterus and vagina because the normal outlet is blocked, often by tissue present from birth. It may cause absent periods, monthly pelvic pain, and a lower-abdominal mass.

Hematomyelia

Bleeding inside the spinal cord, usually after a serious injury or from an abnormal blood vessel or bleeding disorder. It may cause sudden neck or back pain, weakness, numbness, or loss of bladder or bowel control.

Hematophobia

An excessive or persistent fear of blood, blood-related sights, or medical procedures involving blood that causes distress or avoidance; some people have a vasovagal fainting response.

Hematopoiesis

The process of making and maturing blood cells, mainly in the bone marrow. It produces red blood cells for oxygen transport, white blood cells for immune defense, and platelets for stopping bleeding.

Hematopoietic Growth Factor

A cytokine or medicine that stimulates production, maturation, or survival of blood-forming cells in bone marrow, such as erythropoietin or granulocyte colony-stimulating factor.

Hematopoietic Neoplasm

A cancer arising from blood-forming cells in the bone marrow or immune tissues. Leukemias, lymphomas, and plasma-cell cancers are examples; symptoms and treatment depend on the exact cell type and extent.

Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation

Infusion of blood-forming stem cells to replace damaged or diseased bone marrow. The cells may come from the patient or a donor. Treatment can cause serious infection, bleeding, infertility, or an immune reaction against donor and recipient tissues.

Hematopoietic System

The bone marrow and related organs and cells that produce, mature, circulate, and remove blood cells, including red cells, white cells, and platelets.

Hematoporphyrin Derivative

A porphyrin-based photosensitizer that accumulates in some tumors and can be activated by light in photodynamic treatment; it may also cause prolonged photosensitivity.

Hematosalpinx

Blood collected inside a fallopian tube, usually causing it to expand. It is often associated with a tubal ectopic pregnancy or endometriosis, though other causes occur. It may cause pelvic pain and can impair fertility if the tube is damaged or blocked. Unlike hydrosalpinx, which contains non-purulent fluid, hematosalpinx contains blood; a pus-filled tube is a pyosalpinx.

Hematosis

The exchange of gases in the lungs: oxygen moves from inhaled air into the blood, while carbon dioxide moves from the blood into the air to be breathed out.

Hematospermia

Blood in the semen, often temporary and associated with infection, inflammation, trauma, or a recent urologic procedure. Persistent or recurrent bleeding, pain, fever, urinary symptoms, or older age can be associated with underlying disease.

Hematoxylin

A dye used in histology, usually with eosin, to stain cell nuclei blue-purple and help show tissue structure.

Hematuria

Blood in the urine. It may be visible as pink, red, or brown urine or found only under a microscope. Causes include infection, stones, medicines, injury, prostate disease, and kidney or urinary-tract disorders.

Heme

Heme is an iron-containing porphyrin group that binds oxygen in haemoglobin and myoglobin and forms the functional centre of several enzymes; abnormal heme metabolism contributes to porphyrias and jaundice.

Hemeralopia

Hemeralopia is reduced vision in bright light, sometimes associated with retinal disorders or abnormal cone function.

Hemianesthesia

The complete loss of tactile, thermal, or nociceptive somatic sensation affecting one vertical half of the body, classically caused by an ischemic or hemorrhagic lesion disrupting the contralateral primary somatosensory cortex or the ventral posterolateral (VPL) nucleus of the thalamus.

Hemianopia

Loss of vision in half of the area a person can see, affecting one or both eyes. It often results from a problem in the brain's visual pathways, such as a stroke or tumor; sudden onset can occur with a serious brain disorder.

Hemianopsia

Alternate term; see *Hemianopia*.

Hemiballism

A movement disorder causing sudden, large-amplitude, flinging movements on one side of the body, usually from a lesion involving the subthalamic region.

Hemiballismus

Alternate spelling; see *Hemiballism*.

Hemicolectomy

Surgical removal of the right or left portion of the colon, sometimes with nearby lymph nodes and reconnection of the bowel.

Hemidesmosome

A specialized junction that anchors basal epithelial cells to the underlying basement membrane by linking intracellular keratin filaments with extracellular matrix proteins.

Hemidiaphragm

One of the two muscular halves of the diaphragm separating the chest from the abdomen and assisting breathing.

Hemifacial Atrophy

Progressive wasting of skin, subcutaneous tissue, muscle, and sometimes bone on one side of the face, also called Parry–Romberg syndrome.

Hemifacial Microsomia

A birth difference in which one side of the face is smaller or less developed than the other, often affecting the jaw, ear, cheek, and nearby soft tissues. Hearing, vision, and spinal differences may also occur.

Hemifacial Spasm

Repeated involuntary twitching on one side of the face, usually beginning around the eye and sometimes spreading to the cheek or mouth. Irritation of the facial nerve is a common cause; persistent spasms need evaluation.

Hemihypertrophy

Unequal overgrowth of one side or region of the body, producing asymmetry of limbs, trunk, or face; some childhood cases carry increased risk of embryonal tumors.

Hemilaryngectomy

Hemilaryngectomy is surgery to remove part of the larynx, usually to treat a selected laryngeal cancer while preserving as much speech and swallowing function as possible.

Hemimandibulectomy

Hemimandibulectomy is surgery to remove one side of the lower jaw, usually for a tumor or severe bone disease, sometimes followed by reconstruction.

Hemimegalencephaly

A rare developmental brain malformation in which one cerebral hemisphere is abnormally enlarged and dysplastic, often causing infantile seizures, developmental impairment, and contralateral neurologic signs.

Hemimelia

A congenital limb-reduction defect in which part or all of a limb segment is absent, such as fibular or radial hemimelia.

Hemineglect

A neurological attentional disorder classically resulting from an acute lesion of the non-dominant (usually right) posterior parietal cortex, in which the patient fails to orient toward, respond to, or perceive sensory stimuli presented in the hemispace contralateral to the brain lesion.

Alternate Names:
Spatial Neglect; Unilateral Neglect

Hemiparesis

Weakness on one side of the body, affecting the face, arm, leg, or a combination. It is less severe than paralysis and may result from stroke, brain injury, a tumor, multiple sclerosis, or another nervous-system disorder.

Hemiparesis with Conjugate Gaze Deviation

Weakness on the left side with both eyes looking to the right. This pattern can occur with a serious injury to the right side of the brain, including stroke, but examination and brain imaging are needed to identify the cause.

Hemipelvectomy

Hemipelvectomy is major surgery that removes part or all of one side of the pelvis, with or without removal of the leg, usually for extensive cancer or severe trauma.

Hemiplegia

Complete or near-complete paralysis of one side of the body, including the face, arm, or leg. It usually results from injury to movement pathways in the brain, commonly a stroke; sudden onset can occur with a serious brain disorder.

Hemispatial Neglect

Hemispatial neglect is reduced awareness of one side of the body or space, usually after injury to the opposite cerebral hemisphere.

Hemispherectomy

Hemispherectomy is surgery that removes or disconnects much of one cerebral hemisphere to treat severe, otherwise uncontrolled epilepsy in selected patients.

Hemisternebra

A congenital or developmental partial segment of the sternum, caused by incomplete formation or fusion of sternal elements and sometimes associated with chest-wall anomalies.

Hemithorax

One side of the thorax, including the lung, pleural space, ribs, and other structures on that side of the chest.

Hemivertebrae

Congenital vertebrae formed from only part of the normal vertebral body, producing wedge-shaped bone and potentially causing congenital scoliosis or spinal-cord abnormalities.

Hemizygous

Having only one copy of a gene or chromosome region rather than the usual pair, as occurs for many X-linked genes in people with one X chromosome.

Hemobilia

Bleeding originating within the hepatobiliary tree that enters the gastrointestinal tract via the ampulla of Vater, classically presenting with the triad of biliary colic, upper gastrointestinal bleeding, and obstructive jaundice (Sandblom triad), frequently following liver trauma, biopsy, or instrumentation.

Hemochromatosis

An inherited genetic disorder that causes the body to absorb and store too much iron from the diet. Because the human body has no natural way to get rid of excess iron, the mineral gradually builds up in vital organs—especially the liver, heart, pancreas, joints, and skin. Over many years, iron toxicity can lead to liver damage (cirrhosis), diabetes, heart failure, arthritis, and chronic fatigue.

Alternate Names:
Hereditary Hemochromatosis; Iron Overload Disorder; Bronze Diabetes

Hemochromatosis Cardiomyopathy

Heart-muscle damage caused by excess iron buildup. The heart may become stiff or weak and cause breathlessness, swelling, abnormal rhythms, or heart failure; treatment aims to remove excess iron and support heart function.

Hemocyanin

A copper-containing oxygen-transport protein in many mollusks and arthropods; unlike human hemoglobin, it circulates dissolved in their hemolymph.

Hemocytometer

A ruled counting chamber used with a microscope to determine the concentration of cells or other particles in a measured volume of fluid.

Hemodialysis

A treatment that cleans blood using a dialyzer with a semipermeable membrane. Waste and excess salts move into the dialysate mainly by diffusion; excess water is removed by ultrafiltration driven by a pressure difference across the membrane. Blood returns to the circulation after passing through the filter. Hemodialysis replaces some kidney functions but not their hormone production or vitamin D activation.

Hemodialysis Access Care

Daily maintenance protocols and hygiene measures for an arteriovenous fistula, arteriovenous graft, or central venous catheter used for hemodialysis. Includes daily palpation for a vascular thrill, avoiding blood pressure cuffs or constrictive clothing on the access arm, and promptly reporting signs of infection or thrombosis.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Access Care; Fistula and Graft Maintenance; Dialysis Access Management

Hemodialysis Access Procedures

Procedures that create, maintain, repair, or revise vascular access for hemodialysis, including fistula or graft creation, catheter placement, angioplasty, thrombectomy, and treatment of stenosis or infection.

Hemodialysis Clearance

The volume of plasma from which hemodialysis removes a solute per unit time; it depends on blood and dialysate flow, membrane properties, treatment time, and the substance's distribution.

Hemodialysis Solution

The dialysate fluid circulated across a semipermeable membrane during hemodialysis to remove waste and help correct electrolyte, acid–base, and fluid abnormalities.

Hemodynamics

The movement of blood through the heart and blood vessels, including pressure, flow, heart output, and resistance. Hemodynamic measurements help assess circulation and guide treatment in conditions such as shock, heart failure, and critical illness.

Hemofiltration

A kidney-support treatment in which blood passes through a semipermeable filter. Pressure drives water and dissolved waste across the membrane by convection, and sterile replacement fluid is added to maintain fluid and salt balance. Pure hemofiltration uses no dialysate; hemodiafiltration combines hemofiltration with diffusion using dialysate.

Hemoglobin

The iron-containing protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen from the lungs to tissues and helps carry carbon dioxide back to the lungs. Low or abnormal hemoglobin can cause anemia or other blood disorders.

Hemoglobin A

The main type of hemoglobin in most adults. It is the oxygen-carrying protein in red blood cells and is made from two alpha and two beta protein parts.

Hemoglobin A1c

A blood test that measures the proportion of hemoglobin with glucose attached at a specific site on its beta chain. The result estimates average blood glucose over roughly the preceding two to three months and helps diagnose and monitor diabetes; it may be less reliable when red-cell survival or hemoglobin structure is abnormal.

Alternate Names:
HbA1c; A1C Test; Hemoglobin A1c Test

Hemoglobin A1C Variability

Factors that can make hemoglobin A1c less reliable include altered red-cell survival, hemoglobin variants, anemia, pregnancy, kidney disease, transfusion, and some treatments. An alternative measure of glucose may be needed when A1c does not reflect recent glycemia.

Hemoglobin C

A beta-globin variant caused by a hemoglobin gene mutation; homozygosity can cause mild hemolytic anemia and splenomegaly, while inheritance with hemoglobin S causes a clinically significant sickling disorder.

Hemoglobin C Disease

An inherited hemoglobinopathy caused by a beta-globin variant that produces hemoglobin C. It may cause mild hemolytic anemia, jaundice, splenomegaly, or, when combined with hemoglobin S, clinically significant sickling disease.

Hemoglobin Electrophoresis

A blood test that separates the different types of hemoglobin. It helps identify inherited conditions such as sickle-cell disease, sickle-cell trait, and thalassemia. Results are interpreted with age, pregnancy, blood counts, recent transfusion, and other tests.

Hemoglobin H

An unusual form of hemoglobin made from four beta protein parts when the body makes too little alpha hemoglobin. It is unstable and can cause ongoing breakdown of red blood cells in alpha-thalassemia.

Hemoglobin Increased

A blood-test result in which hemoglobin concentration is above the laboratory's reference range. Dehydration can raise the concentration by reducing plasma volume; chronic low oxygen or a bone-marrow disorder can raise the number of red blood cells. Hematocrit and red-cell count help distinguish these causes.

Hemoglobin M

A group of abnormal hemoglobins that stabilize iron in the ferric state and can cause congenital methemoglobinemia and cyanosis.

Hemoglobin Normal Values

Reference ranges for blood hemoglobin concentration, which vary with age, sex, pregnancy, altitude, laboratory method, and other factors; the reporting laboratory's range applies to its results.

Hemoglobinopathies

A group of inherited disorders affecting the structure or production of hemoglobin. They include sickle-cell disorders and thalassemias and may cause anemia, hemolysis, abnormal oxygen transport, or blood-vessel complications.

Hemoglobinopathies: Thalassemias

Thalassemias are inherited disorders of globin chain synthesis imbalance: alpha-thalassemia (HBA1/HBA2 deletions) and beta-thalassemia (HBB mutations).

Hemoglobinopathy

An inherited disorder affecting the structure or production of hemoglobin. Examples include sickle-cell disease and thalassemia; effects range from no symptoms to anemia, painful blood-vessel blockages, and organ damage.

Hemoglobin S

An inherited form of hemoglobin that can make red blood cells become stiff and sickle-shaped when oxygen is low. It can cause anemia, painful blockages, and organ damage in sickle-cell disease.

Hemoglobin SC Disease

An inherited form of sickle cell disease caused by having one hemoglobin S gene and one hemoglobin C gene. It can cause anemia, pain episodes, and organ complications.

Alternate Names:
HbSC; Sickle-Hemoglobin C Disease

Hemoglobin Test

A blood test measuring the concentration of hemoglobin, the iron-containing protein that transports oxygen in red blood cells; see *Hemoglobin* and *Complete Blood Count*.

Hemoglobin Trait

The inherited presence of a hemoglobin variant in a heterozygous state, usually causing no symptoms but potentially affecting screening results or reproductive risk.

Hemoglobinuria

Haemoglobinuria is free haemoglobin in urine, usually from intravascular haemolysis; urine may be dipstick-positive for blood with few or no red cells, and causes include transfusion reactions, malaria, and paroxysmal nocturnal haemoglobinuria.

Hemoglobinuria Test

A urine test used to detect free hemoglobin released when red blood cells break apart in the bloodstream. A urine dipstick detects heme but may also react to intact red blood cells or myoglobin; urine microscopy helps distinguish hemoglobinuria from bleeding into the urinary tract.

Hemogram

See *Complete Blood Count*.

Hemolysin

A toxin or immune substance that damages the outer covering of red blood cells and makes them break open. Some bacteria produce hemolysins, and the resulting destruction of red cells is called hemolysis.

Hemolysis

Breakdown of red blood cells, releasing hemoglobin. It may occur within blood vessels or as cells are removed by the spleen and liver; excessive hemolysis can cause anemia, jaundice, or dark urine.

Hemolytic

Relating to hemolysis, the premature destruction of red blood cells, which can release hemoglobin and produce anemia or jaundice.

Hemolytic Anemia

Anemia caused by red blood cells being destroyed faster than the body can replace them. It may result from an inherited cell problem, an immune reaction, infection, medicine, toxin, or another illness and can cause jaundice and dark urine.

Hemolytic Anemia From Toxins

Anemia caused by accelerated destruction of red blood cells after exposure to a chemical or toxin; evaluation identifies hemolysis and removes or treats the responsible exposure.

Hemolytic Anemias: Autoimmune

Anemias in which the immune system mistakenly destroys red blood cells. Warm-antibody and cold-antibody forms differ in triggers and temperature sensitivity; symptoms may include tiredness, jaundice, dark urine, and breathlessness.

Hemolytic Anemias: Hereditary

Inherited conditions in which red blood cells are destroyed too quickly. Hereditary spherocytosis is one example; it can cause anemia, jaundice, an enlarged spleen, and gallstones. Other inherited red-cell or enzyme problems can cause similar anemia.

Hemolytic Crisis

A sudden increase in red-cell destruction causing worsening anemia, jaundice, dark urine, pain, or other manifestations of hemolysis.

Hemolytic Disease Of The Fetus And Newborn

A condition in which antibodies from the pregnant person cross the placenta and destroy the fetus's red blood cells; the antibodies may continue to affect the newborn after birth. It can cause anemia and jaundice, and severe cases can cause widespread fluid buildup or brain injury.

Hemolytic Index

A laboratory-quality indicator estimating hemolysis in a blood specimen; substantial in-vitro hemolysis can interfere with measurement of several analytes.

Hemolytic Jaundice

Jaundice resulting from excessive hemolysis (breakdown of red blood cells) causing overproduction of unconjugated bilirubin that exceeds the liver's capacity for conjugation and excretion. See *Jaundice* for complete overview.

Hemolytic Transfusion Reaction

An immune or nonimmune complication in which transfused red blood cells are destroyed, potentially causing fever, pain, hemoglobinuria, kidney injury, shock, or disseminated intravascular coagulation.

Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome

A serious illness in which tiny blood clots damage small blood vessels, causing red blood cells to break apart, platelets to fall, and the kidneys to become injured. It often follows severe diarrheal infection but can have other causes.

Hemolytic-Uremic Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome*.

Hemoperfusion

A treatment in which blood passes through a material such as charcoal or resin that traps selected

poisons or medicines. It is used only for certain severe overdoses because effectiveness depends on the substance and timing.

Hemopericardium

Accumulation of blood in the pericardial sac around the heart. If pressure rises and prevents the heart from filling, cardiac tamponade can occur.

Hemoperitoneum

Blood collecting inside the abdominal cavity, usually from trauma, a ruptured blood vessel or organ, surgery, or a ruptured ectopic pregnancy. It can cause abdominal pain, distention, dizziness, or shock and may require emergency imaging and surgery or another procedure.

Hemopexin

A plasma glycoprotein that binds free heme and transports it to the liver, helping limit oxidative injury during hemolysis.

Hemophagocytic Lymphohistiocytosis

A rare, potentially life-threatening syndrome in which immune cells become overactive and cause widespread inflammation that can damage organs. It may be inherited or develop in association with an infection, cancer, or immune disorder. Common features include persistent fever, an enlarged spleen, low blood-cell counts, liver problems, bleeding, or neurologic symptoms such as confusion.

Hemophagocytosis Of Sickle Cells

A finding in which immune cells engulf blood cells in the bone marrow or other tissues during severe inflammation, infection, or sickle-cell complications. It can worsen anemia and low platelet counts and requires specialist evaluation.

Hemophilia

A rare, inherited bleeding disorder in which the blood cannot clot properly because it lacks sufficient amounts of specific blood-clotting proteins. Usually affecting males and passed down through carrier mothers, the most common forms are extbfhemophilia A (lack of clotting factor VIII) and extbfhemophilia B (lack of clotting factor IX). People with hemophilia bleed for a longer time after an injury and can experience painful, damaging internal bleeding into joints and muscles without an obvious injury.

Alternate Names:
Haemophilia; Inherited Coagulopathy

Hemophilia A

An inherited bleeding disorder caused by too little or poorly working clotting factor VIII. It usually follows an X-linked inheritance pattern but can cause bleeding symptoms in people of any sex. Severity varies with factor VIII activity.

Hemophilia B

An inherited bleeding disorder caused by too little or poorly working clotting factor IX. It usually follows an X-linked inheritance pattern but can cause bleeding symptoms in people of any sex. Severity varies with factor IX activity.

Hemophilic Arthritis

Chronic joint damage caused by repeated bleeding into a joint, usually in people with hemophilia. Recurrent bleeds inflame and thicken the joint lining and can progressively damage cartilage and bone, causing pain, stiffness, and reduced movement.

Alternate Names:
Hemophilic Arthropathy; Haemophilic Arthropathy; Haemophilic Arthritis

Hemophilus

An older spelling or variant of Haemophilus, a group of small gram-negative bacteria that includes respiratory and genital pathogens.

Hemophilus Ducreyi

A gram-negative bacterium that causes chancroid, a sexually transmitted infection with painful genital ulcers and tender lymph nodes.

Hemophobia

An excessive or persistent fear of blood, also called hematophobia, that causes significant dis-

tress, avoidance, or sometimes a vasovagal faint.

Hemopoietic Stem Cell

A blood-forming stem cell found mainly in the bone marrow. It can make copies of itself and develop into red blood cells, white blood cells, or platelets.

Alternate Names:
Hematopoietic Stem Cell (HSC); Blood-Forming Cell

Hemopoietic Tissue

Tissue that produces blood cells, chiefly bone marrow, containing stem cells and supporting cells that generate erythrocytes, leukocytes, and platelets.

Hemoprotein

A protein containing a heme group with an iron atom, such as hemoglobin, myoglobin, cytochromes, and many oxidoreductive enzymes.

Hemoptysis

Coughing up blood or blood-stained mucus from the airways or lungs. Causes include infection, irritated or widened airways, a blood clot, or cancer. Larger amounts may occur with breathlessness or chest pain.

Hemorrhage

Abnormal escape of blood from a damaged blood vessel or, less commonly, from the heart. It may be external or internal, acute or chronic, and range from minor bleeding to life-threatening blood loss causing anemia, shock, or organ compression; the cause and site determine management.

Hemorrhagic

Pertaining to or characterized by hemorrhage (extravasation of blood from vessels). Used in contexts such as hemorrhagic stroke, hemorrhagic shock, and hemorrhagic fever.

Hemorrhagic Anemia

Anemia caused by losing blood faster than the body can replace it. Blood loss may be sudden, such as after an injury, or slow, such as from heavy menstrual or intestinal bleeding.

Hemorrhagic Disorder

A condition that causes abnormal bleeding because of platelet number or function, clotting-factor deficiency, excessive fibrinolysis, or blood-vessel fragility.

Hemorrhagic Fever

A group of severe viral illnesses that can disrupt vascular function or blood clotting. Some cause bleeding, low blood pressure, shock, or organ failure; bleeding is not present in every case. Examples include Ebola, Marburg, dengue, and yellow fever.

Alternate Names:
Viral Hemorrhagic Fever; VHF; Hemorrhagic Fevers

Hemorrhagic Shock

Circulatory failure caused by severe blood loss. It may produce rapid pulse, low blood pressure, cool skin, reduced urine output, confusion, or collapse. Treatment focuses on controlling bleeding, restoring circulating volume, giving blood products when indicated, and correcting associated injuries or clotting abnormalities.

Hemorrhagic Stroke

A stroke caused by a blood vessel breaking and bleeding in or around the brain. It can cause sudden weakness, speech or vision problems, severe headache, vomiting, confusion, or loss of consciousness. The effects depend on the location and amount of bleeding.

Hemorrhagic Thyroid Nodule

Bleeding into a lump in the thyroid gland can cause sudden neck swelling or pain. It often occurs in a fluid-filled cyst or other thyroid nodule. Ultrasound can show blood within the lump, but further testing may be needed to identify its cause and determine whether the nodule is benign.

Alternate Names:
Intrathyroidal Hemorrhage; Hemorrhagic Thyroid Cyst; Bleeding Into A Thyroid Nodule; Thyroid Nodule Bleed

Hemorrhoid

Singular form; see *Hemorrhoids*.

Hemorrhoidal Hemorrhage

Rectal bleeding from enlarged or injured hemorrhoidal vessels, usually bright red and associated with defecation; heavy, persistent, painful, or unexplained bleeding requires evaluation for other causes.

Hemorrhoidectomy

An operation to remove enlarged hemorrhoids that continue to bleed, prolapse, clot, or cause severe symptoms despite other treatment. Recovery may include significant pain, bleeding, difficulty passing urine, or temporary bowel discomfort.

Hemorrhoids

Enlarged blood-vessel cushions in the lower rectum or anus, often associated with straining, constipation, or pregnancy. Internal hemorrhoids may cause painless, bright-red bleeding or tissue that bulges during bowel movements. External hemorrhoids lie under sensitive skin and can become painful, especially when a blood clot forms. Rectal bleeding can also have other causes.

Alternate Names:
Piles; Hemorrhoidal Disease; Haemorrhoids

Hemorrhoid Surgery

An operation to remove or reduce symptomatic internal or external hemorrhoids when bleeding, prolapse, thrombosis, or pain persists despite appropriate conservative treatment.

Hemosiderin

An iron-containing pigment left in cells after hemoglobin from red blood cells is broken down. It can build up after repeated bleeding, excessive red-cell destruction, or too much iron in the body.

Hemosiderosis

Excess deposition of hemosiderin, an iron-storage pigment, in tissues. It may follow repeated bleeding or transfusions and can affect organs such as the lungs or liver.

Hemosiderotic Synovitis

Synovial inflammation with hemosiderin deposition caused by recurrent bleeding into a joint, commonly associated with hemophilia, anticoagulation, trauma, or a vascular synovial lesion.

Hemospermia

The presence of blood in semen, usually caused by inflammation or infection of the genitourinary tract and often self-limited, but persistent or recurrent cases require evaluation.

Hemostasis

The body's process for stopping bleeding after a blood vessel is injured. Blood vessels narrow, platelets form a plug, and clotting proteins strengthen it; later, the body removes the clot as healing occurs.

Hemostasis And Coagulation

The linked processes that stop bleeding. Blood vessels narrow, platelets make a plug, and clotting proteins form a stronger clot. Problems with these processes can cause excessive bleeding or unwanted clots.

Hemostasis Valve

A valve or sealing device used with an intravascular catheter or sheath to limit blood loss while allowing passage of wires or instruments.

Hemostat

A surgical clamping instrument with jaws that compress a blood vessel or tissue to control bleeding during a procedure. Many hemostats have a ratcheted locking mechanism that maintains pressure without continuous hand force.

Alternate Names:
Hemostatic Forceps; Artery Clamp

Hemostatic Agent

A medicine or material used to stop or reduce bleeding. It may form a physical seal, help the blood clot, slow clot breakdown, or replace a missing clotting protein.

Hemothorax

Blood collecting in the space between the lung and chest wall, usually after injury or surgery. It can cause chest pain, breathlessness, low blood pressure, and reduced breath sounds; treatment often includes drainage and control of the bleeding source.

Hemovac Drain

A closed-suction surgical drain with a compressible reservoir used to remove blood or other fluid from a wound or operative site.

Henderson-Hasselbalch Equation

A mathematical derivation expressing the relationship between blood pH, the dissociation constant (pKa) of carbonic acid (6.1), and the ratio of serum bicarbonate concentration to dissolved arterial carbon dioxide tension (0.03 times PaCO2), forming the quantitative framework for clinical acid-base interpretation.

Hendra Virus

A rare zoonotic virus carried by fruit bats that can infect horses and occasionally humans through close contact with infected horses. Human disease may cause severe respiratory or neurologic illness and is managed as a public-health concern.

Henipavirus

A genus of paramyxoviruses that includes Nipah and Hendra viruses, which can cause severe encephalitis and respiratory disease.

Henle Loop

The U-shaped hairpin segment of a renal nephron connecting the proximal convoluted tubule to the distal convoluted tubule, consisting of a water-permeable descending limb and an active sodium-potassium-chloride-transporting ascending limb that generates a hypertonic medullary interstitial gradient for urine concentration.

Alternate Names:
Loop of Henle; Ansa Nephroni

Henna

A plant dye used on skin, hair, and textiles. Natural henna is usually orange-brown; so-called black henna may contain para-phenylenediamine, which can cause severe allergic skin reactions and permanent scarring.

Henoch-Schonlein Purpura

Older name; see *IgA Vasculitis*.

Henoch-Schönlein Purpura

Alternate spelling; see *IgA Vasculitis*.

Henoch-Schonlein Purpura (HSP)

Alternate name; see *IgA Vasculitis*.

Alternate Names:
IgA Vasculitis; Anaphylactoid Purpura; Schönlein-Henoch Syndrome

HEPA Filter

A high-efficiency air filter that removes most very small airborne particles. It can reduce dust, allergens, and some infectious particles when properly fitted and maintained, but does not remove every gas or chemical.

Alternate Names:
High-Efficiency Particulate Air Filter

Hepar

Latin for liver; it is used in medical terminology and in names of substances or preparations relating to the liver.

Heparan Sulfate

A sulfated glycosaminoglycan in cell surfaces and extracellular matrix that binds growth factors, regulates signaling, and contributes to filtration-barrier and connective-tissue structure.

Heparin

An anticoagulant medicine that reduces blood clotting by enhancing antithrombin activity. It may be given by injection to prevent or treat blood clots.

Heparin Binding

The attachment of a protein or other molecule to heparin, a highly charged substance related to blood clotting. Binding can alter the molecule's activity, movement, or laboratory measurement.

Heparin-Induced Thrombocytopenia

An immune reaction to heparin that lowers the platelet count while making dangerous blood clots more likely. It usually begins several days after heparin exposure. Management involves discontinuing heparin and using a different anticoagulant.

Heparin Resistance

The clinical situation in which unusually high doses of unfractionated heparin (exceeding 35,000 units per 24 hours) are required to achieve a therapeutic activated partial thromboplastin time (aPTT) or anti-factor Xa level, most commonly caused by antithrombin deficiency, acute-phase reactant elevations, or high factor VIII levels.

Hepatectomy

Surgery to remove part or, rarely, nearly all of the liver, usually to treat a tumor or severe localized liver disease. Adequate function depends on the size and health of the remaining liver. Bleeding, bile leakage, infection, and liver failure are major risks.

Alternate Names:
Liver Resection

Hepatic

Relating to the liver. The liver processes nutrients and medicines, makes bile and important blood proteins, stores energy, and helps remove harmful substances; hepatic disease can affect one or several of these functions.

Hepatic Adenoma

Alternate name; see *Hepatocellular Adenoma*.

Hepatic Artery

The main artery supplying oxygen-rich blood to the liver. It divides into branches that deliver blood to the right and left parts of the organ.

Hepatic Artery Aneurysm

An abnormal localized enlargement of the hepatic artery, generally defined as at least 1.5 times its expected diameter. It may be a true aneurysm involving the artery wall or a pseudoaneurysm, a contained leak after wall injury; rupture can cause severe bleeding into the abdomen or bile ducts.

Hepatic Amyloidosis

Buildup of abnormal protein deposits in the liver as part of amyloidosis, a disease that can affect several organs. It may enlarge the liver or change liver blood tests, but often causes no liver symptoms. Severe liver damage is uncommon.

Hepatic Artery Embolization

A catheter-based procedure that blocks selected branches of the hepatic artery, often to reduce blood supply to a liver tumor or control bleeding. When chemotherapy is also delivered, the procedure is called transarterial chemoembolization.

Alternate Names:
Selective Hepatic Artery Embolization

Hepatic Artery Occlusion

Partial or complete blockage of the hepatic artery, usually caused by a blood clot, embolus, inflammation, injury, or a procedure. It may reduce blood flow to the liver and cause liver infarction or ischemic hepatitis, especially when portal-vein blood flow is also reduced.

Hepatic Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Liver Biopsy*.

Hepatic Coma

Severe loss of consciousness caused by advanced liver failure and buildup of toxic substances in the blood. It is a medical emergency, often preceded by confusion, sleepiness, personality change, or hand-flapping movements.

Hepatic Cyst

A fluid-filled sac in the liver. Most simple liver cysts cause no symptoms and are found by chance on

imaging. Cysts that are large, infected, bleeding, parasitic, or complex may cause pain, pressure, fever, or other problems.

Alternate Names:
Liver Cyst; Simple Liver Cyst

Hepatic Dose Adjustment

Changing a medicine or its dose because liver disease may slow its breakdown or removal. The correct adjustment depends on the medicine, liver function, other illnesses, and monitoring of benefit and toxicity.

Hepatic Duct

The duct formed by the union of the right and left liver ducts, carrying bile from the liver toward the common bile duct and intestine.

Hepatic Encephalopathy

Changes in thinking, alertness, behavior, or movement caused when poor liver function or blood bypassing the liver allows substances to affect the brain. Severe cases can lead to coma. Infection, bleeding, constipation, or some medicines can trigger or worsen it.

Hepatic Fibrosis

Alternate name; see *Liver Fibrosis*.

Hepatic Fissure

A natural groove or cleft on the liver's surface. It separates parts of the liver and may contain or provide a route for blood vessels, bile ducts, or supporting ligaments.

Hepatic Flexure

The bend where the right-sided ascending colon turns into the transverse colon near the liver. It is a normal anatomical landmark that may be seen during imaging, surgery, or colonoscopy.

Hepatic Granulomas

Small collections of immune cells that form in the liver in response to infections, medicines, sarcoidosis, or other inflammatory conditions. They often cause no symptoms, but the underlying condition may cause abnormal liver tests, bile-duct blockage, fibrosis, or portal hypertension.

Hepatic Hemangioma

A benign liver lesion made of blood-filled vascular spaces. Most are small, cause no symptoms, and are found incidentally on imaging; larger lesions can cause abdominal discomfort or fullness, while rupture and bleeding are very rare.

Hepatic Hydatid Cyst

A slow-growing cyst in the liver caused by the larval stage of an Echinococcus tapeworm. It may cause no symptoms for years. If it leaks or bursts, it can trigger a severe allergic reaction or spread the infection.

Hepatic Hydrothorax

A buildup of fluid around a lung caused by severe liver disease and high pressure in the abdomen. It is usually on the right side and can cause breathlessness; treatment focuses on the liver disease and fluid control.

Hepatic Ischemia

Liver injury caused by inadequate hepatic blood flow or oxygen delivery, often during shock, severe hypoxemia, cardiac failure, or hepatic vascular occlusion. It can produce a rapid, marked rise in aminotransferases and may progress to acute liver failure.

Hepatic Lamina

A sheet of cells in a developing embryo that contributes to the liver and its bile ducts.

Hepatic Necrosis

Death of liver cells caused by severe ischemia, toxins, viral infection, autoimmune injury, or other insults; extensive necrosis can produce acute liver failure.

Hepatic Portal System

A network of veins that carries blood from the digestive organs, spleen, and pancreas to the liver before

the blood returns to the heart. The liver processes nutrients, medicines, and harmful substances in this blood.

Hepatic Sarcoidosis

Sarcoidosis affecting the liver, where small clumps of immune cells called granulomas form. It often causes no symptoms but may change liver blood tests, enlarge the liver, or cause itching or jaundice. Long-lasting disease can scar the liver or raise pressure in its blood vessels.

Hepatic Sinusoidal Obstruction Syndrome

A potentially severe liver injury caused by narrowing or blockage of hepatic sinusoids, classically after hematopoietic-cell transplantation or certain chemotherapy. Painful liver enlargement, weight gain, fluid retention, jaundice, and rising bilirubin may occur.

Alternate Names:
Veno-Occlusive Hepatic Disease; Hepatic Veno-Occlusive Disease; VOD/SOS

Hepatic Steatosis

Excess accumulation of fat in liver cells, commonly called fatty liver; causes include metabolic disease, alcohol, medicines, and other conditions, and inflammation or fibrosis may develop in some people.

Hepatic Surgery

Surgical treatment of liver disease, including partial liver resection, transplantation, and procedures for tumors or biliary disorders. The operation depends on the diagnosis, tumor extent, liver function, and overall health.

Hepatic Synthetic Dysfunction

Reduced ability of the liver to make important proteins, including albumin and blood-clotting factors. It can cause swelling, easy bleeding, or abnormal clotting tests, although other problems such as vitamin K deficiency or blood-thinning medicines can also alter these tests.

Hepatic Trauma

Liver injury caused by blunt or penetrating trauma, potentially producing internal bleeding and requiring urgent imaging, monitoring, or surgery based on severity.

Hepatic Tuberculosis

Infection of the liver by tuberculosis bacteria, usually as part of infection affecting several organs. It can cause fever, weight loss, poor appetite, abdominal pain, or an enlarged liver. Small lumps of immune cells called granulomas may form in the liver.

Hepatic Vein

One of the veins that carries blood away from the liver and into the large vein leading to the heart. The main hepatic veins drain different regions of the liver.

Hepatic Vein Obstruction

Obstruction of hepatic venous outflow, usually from thrombosis or compression, causing abdominal pain, hepatomegaly, ascites, and potentially liver failure.

Hepatic Vein Thrombosis

A blood clot that blocks one or more veins carrying blood out of the liver. Hepatic venous outflow obstruction from a clot is commonly called Budd-Chiari syndrome; it can cause liver enlargement, upper-abdominal pain, and fluid buildup in the abdomen.

Hepatitis

Hepatitis is inflammation of the liver caused by viruses, alcohol, medications, toxins, metabolic disease, or autoimmunity and may be acute or chronic.

Hepatitis A

A short-term liver infection caused by hepatitis A virus. It spreads when virus from infected stool is swallowed, often through close contact or contaminated food or water. It may cause fever, tiredness, nausea, abdominal discomfort, or jaundice. Most people recover completely; chronic infection is not expected. Vaccination helps prevent it.

Hepatitis A Virus

The virus that causes hepatitis A. It spreads when virus from infected stool is swallowed, commonly through contaminated food, water, or close contact. It causes a short-term liver infection that may produce fever, nausea, tiredness, dark urine, pale stools, or jaundice; vaccination helps prevent it.

Hepatitis B

A liver infection caused by the hepatitis B virus (HBV). It spreads when infected blood, semen, or certain other body fluids enter another person's body, including through sex, shared needles or equipment, or from an infected parent to a baby around the time of birth. Infection may be acute (short-term) or chronic (long-term). Many people have no symptoms. When symptoms occur, they may include tiredness, fever, loss of appetite, nausea, abdominal pain, joint pain, dark urine, pale stools, or yellow skin and eyes (jaundice). Chronic infection, especially when acquired in infancy or childhood, can cause liver damage, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer. Vaccination prevents hepatitis B.

Hepatitis B Surface Antigen Test

A serologic blood test detecting the surface antigen (HBsAg) of the hepatitis B virus, indicating active acute or chronic infection; see *Hepatitis B* and *Hepatitis B Virus*.

Hepatitis B Virus

The virus that causes hepatitis B. HBV spreads when infected blood, semen, or certain other body fluids enter another person's body, including through sex, shared needles or equipment, or around childbirth. It can cause acute (short-term) or chronic (long-term) liver infection. Chronic infection can cause liver damage, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer. Vaccination prevents hepatitis B.

Hepatitis B Window Period

The interval during acute resolving hepatitis B virus infection between the disappearance of detectable hepatitis B surface antigen (HBsAg) and the appearance of protective anti-HBs antibodies, during which IgM antibody to hepatitis B core antigen (anti-HBc IgM) serves as the sole serological marker of acute infection.

Hepatitis C

A liver infection caused by the hepatitis C virus (HCV). It spreads mainly when infected blood enters another person's body, especially through shared injection equipment; it can also spread through some other blood exposures and, less often, through sex or from an infected parent to a baby. Acute infection often causes no symptoms, and some people clear the virus without treatment. In many others it becomes chronic (long-term) and can cause liver damage, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer. Direct-acting antiviral medicines cure more than 95% of infections in most people; no vaccine is available.

Hepatitis C Antibody Test

A serologic blood test that screens for antibodies against the hepatitis C virus, indicating past or present infection; see *Hepatitis C* and *Hepatitis C Virus*.

Hepatitis C Virus

The virus that causes hepatitis C. HCV spreads mainly when infected blood enters another person's body, especially through shared needles or other injection equipment. It can also spread through some medical exposures, from an infected parent to a baby, or less often through sex. Many people have no symptoms. The infection may be acute (short-term) or become chronic (long-term), which can cause liver damage, cirrhosis, liver failure, or liver cancer. Modern antiviral medicines cure more than 95% of infections in most people, but no vaccine is available.

Hepatitis D

A liver infection caused by the hepatitis D virus (HDV). HDV can infect only people who also have hepatitis B because it needs hepatitis B virus (HBV) to reproduce. Infection with both viruses at the same time is called coinfection; getting HDV after already having HBV is called superinfection. Superinfection is more likely to cause long-term liver

disease, cirrhosis, liver failure, or death.

Hepatitis D Virus

A virus that can multiply only when hepatitis B virus is also present. It spreads through infected blood or body fluids and can make hepatitis B more severe, increasing the risk of cirrhosis and liver cancer. Hepatitis B vaccination also prevents hepatitis D.

Hepatitis E

A liver infection caused by the hepatitis E virus (HEV). It usually spreads when people swallow water or food contaminated with stool, and it can also spread through undercooked meat from infected animals. It usually causes a short-term illness, often with tiredness, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, dark urine, pale stools, or jaundice. Severe illness is more likely during pregnancy and in some people with weakened immune systems. Rarely, infection becomes chronic in people with weakened immunity. No vaccine is available in the United States.

Hepatitis E Virus

The virus that causes hepatitis E. HEV usually spreads through water or food contaminated with stool and can also spread through undercooked meat from infected animals. It commonly causes short-term liver infection, but it may cause severe illness during pregnancy and can occasionally become chronic in people with weakened immune systems. No vaccine is available in the United States.

Hepatitis Serology

Blood testing for antibodies, antigens, and other markers of hepatitis viruses. The results may show a current or past infection, immunity from vaccination, or whether infection has become chronic. Different viruses require different tests. For example, hepatitis B testing commonly includes hepatitis B surface antigen and antibodies to hepatitis B surface and core antigens; hepatitis C testing usually starts with an antibody test and uses an HCV RNA test to show current infection. Results depend on the virus, timing, vaccination history, and other laboratory findings, so a single result may not give the full answer.

Hepatitis Virus

Any one of a heterogeneous group of unrelated, hepatotropic human viruses that share a primary tropism for hepatocytes, provoking necroinflammatory liver injury (viral hepatitis). Classified alphabetically into five primary viral agents (A through E), differing markedly in viral structure, genomic composition, mode of transmission, and propensity for chronicity: (1) Hepatitis A virus (HAV; single-stranded RNA picornavirus, transmitted via the fecal-oral route through contaminated food/water, causing acute, self-limiting hepatitis without a chronic carrier state); (2) Hepatitis B virus (HBV; partially double-stranded circular DNA hepadnavirus, transmitted via parenteral, sexual, or perinatal vertical routes, capable of establishing chronic infection, cirrhosis, and hepatocellular carcinoma, with outcome governed by host immune clearance and viral HBeAg/HBsAg status); (3) Hepatitis C virus (HCV; single-stranded RNA flavivirus, transmitted primarily through parenteral blood exposure [intravenous drug use, contaminated blood products prior to 1992], establishing chronic infection in $\approx$ 75–85% of exposed individuals, leading to progressive liver fibrosis, cirrhosis, and hepatoma, now curable with direct-acting antivirals [DAAs]); (4) Hepatitis D virus (HDV; defective single-stranded circular RNA delta-virus requiring the surface antigen [HBsAg] of HBV to assemble its envelope and propagate, occurring either as a coinfection with HBV or a superinfection in an established HBV carrier, conferring severe, rapidly progressive liver failure); and (5) Hepatitis E virus (HEV; single-stranded RNA hepevirus, transmitted via the fecal-oral route, causing self-limiting acute hepatitis with an extraordinarily high mortality rate [15–25%] due to fulminant hepatic necrosis in pregnant females).

Alternate Names:
Hepatitis Viruses; Hepatotropic Viruses

Hepatitis Viruses

Plural form; see *Hepatitis Virus*.

Hepatitis Virus Panel

A group of blood tests, usually done on one blood sample, that looks for signs of hepatitis A, B, and C infection. The tests may detect viral antigens or antibodies and may show a current infection, a past infection, or immunity after vaccination. The usual panel does not automatically test for hepatitis D or E, which require separate tests when appropriate. A positive antibody result does not always mean that the virus is still present; additional tests may be needed to confirm current infection.

Hepatobiliary

Relating to the liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts. The hepatobiliary system makes bile in the liver, stores and concentrates it in the gallbladder, and carries it through the bile ducts to the small intestine, where it helps digest fats. It also includes the liver's roles in processing nutrients, medicines, and waste products.

Hepatobiliary Scintigraphy

A nuclear-medicine scan, often called a HIDA scan, that uses a small injected radioactive tracer to follow bile movement through the liver, bile ducts, gallbladder, and small intestine. A special camera records the tracer over time. The scan can show blocked bile flow, whether the gallbladder fills and empties normally, bile leaks, and findings that support acute gallbladder inflammation or other biliary disorders.

Alternate Names:
Biliary Scintigraphy; Cholescintigraphy; HIDA Scan; Hepatobiliary Iminodiacetic Acid Scan

Hepatobiliary System

The liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts. The liver makes and secretes bile, the gallbladder stores and concentrates it, and the bile ducts carry it to the small intestine, where it helps digest fats and carry some waste products out of the liver. The liver also processes nutrients and many medicines and toxins.

Hepatoblastoma

A rare cancer that begins in the liver and is the most common type of liver cancer in children. It usually affects children younger than 3 years. A child may have no symptoms until the tumor grows larger; possible findings include a lump or swelling in the abdomen, abdominal pain, poor appetite, nausea, vomiting, or unexplained weight loss. Evaluation may include imaging and blood tests, especially the tumor marker alpha-fetoprotein (AFP); a tissue sample may be used when needed to confirm the diagnosis.

Hepatocellular Adenoma

A rare, usually noncancerous tumor made of mature liver cells. It occurs most often in women of reproductive age and is associated with estrogen exposure, although it can also occur with anabolic steroid use, certain inherited metabolic diseases, or without a known cause. It is often found by chance on imaging and may cause no symptoms. Larger tumors can bleed or rupture, and a small number can change into liver cancer, especially certain subtypes.

Alternate Names:
HCA

Hepatocellular Carcinoma

A cancer that begins in liver cells called hepatocytes. It is the most common primary liver cancer in adults. It often develops in a liver affected by long-term disease, especially cirrhosis, chronic hepatitis B or C, fatty liver inflammation, or long-term heavy alcohol use, but it can occur without a known risk factor. Early disease may cause no symptoms. Later findings may include a lump or pain in the upper-right abdomen, abdominal swelling, jaundice, tiredness, poor appetite, or unexplained weight loss. Diagnosis may use imaging, liver blood tests, and the tumor marker alpha-fetoprotein (AFP); a tissue sample is sometimes needed.

Hepatocellular Jaundice

Jaundice caused by impaired liver cells. Injured hepatocytes cannot take up, change into a water-soluble form, or remove bilirubin normally, so bilirubin builds up in the blood and makes the skin and whites of the eyes yellow. Urine may become dark and stools may become pale; itching, tiredness, nausea, or abdominal discomfort may also

occur. Causes include viral or autoimmune hepatitis, alcohol-related liver disease, medicines or toxins, cirrhosis, hemochromatosis, and Wilson disease.

Hepatocerebral Degeneration

Usually referring to acquired hepatocerebral degeneration, a rare long-term brain disorder linked to advanced liver disease or a portosystemic shunt, an abnormal connection that lets blood bypass the liver. Harmful substances that are normally cleared by the liver, including excess manganese and other neurotoxins, can affect brain areas involved in movement and thinking. Symptoms may include tremor, slowed movement or parkinsonism, poor coordination, unsteady walking, speech changes, abnormal movements, mood or personality changes, and problems with thinking or memory. It is different from the short-lived episodes of hepatic encephalopathy, although the conditions can overlap.

Hepatocyte

The main working cell of the liver. Hepatocytes process carbohydrates, fats, proteins, medicines, and other substances from the blood. They make bile, albumin, clotting factors, and other blood proteins; store energy as glycogen; change ammonia into urea; and help remove or break down harmful substances. Injury to hepatocytes can reduce these functions and raise liver enzymes in the blood.

Hepatoduodenal Ligament

The thickened free right margin of the lesser omentum extending between the liver and the first part of the duodenum, transmitting the portal triad (common bile duct anterolaterally, proper hepatic artery anteromedially, and portal vein posteriorly) and forming the anterior boundary of the epiploic foramen.

Hepatojugular Reflux

A bedside physical sign, also called abdominojugular reflux. Firm, steady pressure on the upper abdomen briefly increases the amount of blood returning to the heart. In a normal response, the jugular veins in the neck rise briefly and then fall while the pressure continues. A sustained rise in jugular venous pressure suggests elevated right-sided heart filling pressure or limited right-ventricle function, often in heart failure. It is a clinical finding, not a diagnosis by itself.

Hepatolenticular Degeneration

Another name for Wilson disease, a rare inherited disorder caused by changes in the *ATP7B* gene. The altered gene prevents the liver from removing excess copper into bile, so copper builds up to harmful levels in the liver, brain, eyes, kidneys, and other tissues. It may cause hepatitis, cirrhosis, or liver failure; tremor, stiffness, poor coordination, speech or mood changes; and green, gold, or brown Kayser–Fleischer rings around the cornea. The disorder is inherited in an autosomal recessive pattern.

Hepatologist

A physician who specializes in diseases of the liver and its connected bile ducts and gallbladder. Hepatologists commonly diagnose and manage hepatitis, fatty liver disease, cirrhosis, jaundice, liver failure, liver tumors, and complications of chronic liver disease. Some also care for related diseases of the pancreas and people being assessed for liver transplantation. Hepatology is usually a subspecialty of gastroenterology.

Hepatology

The branch of medicine concerned mainly with the liver and also with the gallbladder, bile ducts, and related pancreas disorders. It covers how these organs work, how their diseases are diagnosed and managed, and complications such as hepatitis, fatty liver disease, cirrhosis, jaundice, bile-flow disorders, liver cancer, and liver failure. Hepatology is usually a subspecialty of gastroenterology.

Hepatoma

An older, nonspecific term for a liver tumor. In some contexts it is used to mean hepatocellular carcinoma, a cancer arising from liver cells, but the word alone does not show whether a tumor is benign or malignant. *Hepatocellular carcinoma* is the preferred term when a malignant liver-cell tumor is meant.

Hepatomegaly

An enlarged liver. A health professional may feel it during an examination or see it on an ultrasound or other scan. It is a sign, not a disease by itself. Causes include infection or inflammation, fatty liver disease, heart problems, blocked bile flow, or cancer. It may cause no symptoms or discomfort under the right ribs.

Hepatopulmonary Syndrome

A complication of liver disease or portal hypertension in which blood vessels inside the lungs become abnormally widened. Blood then passes through the lungs without receiving enough oxygen, causing low oxygen levels in the blood. Symptoms may include shortness of breath, bluish skin, or clubbing of the fingers. Breathing difficulty and low oxygen may become worse when sitting or standing and improve when lying down; this pattern is called platypnea and orthodeoxia. The condition is identified by liver disease or portal hypertension, impaired oxygenation, and evidence of widened vessels inside the lungs.

Hepatorenal Recess

The deep peritoneal space located posteroinferiorly between the visceral surface of the right hepatic lobe and the right kidney, representing the most gravity-dependent recess of the upper abdomen in the supine position where free intraperitoneal fluid or blood preferentially collects.

Alternate Names:
Morison Pouch

Hepatorenal Syndrome

Serious kidney dysfunction that occurs mainly in advanced cirrhosis, usually with portal hypertension and ascites. Widening of blood vessels in the abdominal circulation lowers the amount of blood effectively reaching the kidneys. The kidneys respond by narrowing their blood vessels and retaining salt and water, so filtration falls even though the kidneys may not initially have a primary structural disease. Hepatorenal syndrome may cause acute kidney injury (HRS-AKI), which develops rapidly, or more persistent kidney dysfunction. Diagnosis requires excluding other important causes of kidney injury, such as shock, dehydration, medicines, infection, or intrinsic kidney disease.

Hepatosplenomegaly

Enlargement of both the liver and spleen at the same time. It is a physical finding rather than a disease itself and may be found during an examination or on imaging. Causes include infections, chronic liver disease with portal hypertension, blood-cell destruction, blood cancers, inherited storage or metabolic disorders, and other infiltrative or inflammatory diseases. It may cause abdominal fullness or discomfort, or no symptoms; other findings depend on the underlying cause. Blood tests and imaging may help identify the cause.

Hepatotoxicity

Toxic injury to the liver caused by a medicine, herbal product, dietary supplement, poison, chemical, or other exposure. The injury may mainly damage liver cells (hepatocellular injury), slow or block bile flow (cholestatic injury), or show both patterns. It may cause no symptoms but can lead to tiredness, nausea, poor appetite, abdominal pain, itching, dark urine, or jaundice, with abnormal liver blood tests. Most cases improve after the cause is removed, but severe injury can cause acute liver failure.

Hepatovirus

A genus in the Picornaviridae family of small RNA viruses. Its best-known human member is hepatitis A virus (HAV), which causes hepatitis A and usually spreads by the fecal–oral route, when virus from stool reaches the mouth through contaminated food, water, hands, or close contact. Other hepatoviruses infect different animal hosts and are not established causes of human disease.

Hepcidin

A peptide hormone made mainly by liver cells and the main regulator of iron balance. When iron stores are high or inflammation is present, hepcidin binds to ferroportin, the protein that exports iron from intestinal cells, macrophages, and liver cells. Ferroportin is then removed, reducing iron absorption

from food and the release of recycled or stored iron into the blood. When iron is low or the bone marrow needs more iron to make red blood cells, hepcidin levels usually fall.

Heptachlor

A persistent organochlorine insecticide formerly used mainly on crops and for termite control. It breaks down slowly into heptachlor epoxide, which can remain in soil and the food chain for a long time. Exposure can occur through contaminated soil, food, water, air, or contact with old treated materials. Studies, especially in animals, associate exposure with effects on the liver, nervous system, reproductive system, and development; evidence of health effects in humans is limited. Most uses have been canceled or severely restricted in the United States.

HER2

Short for human epidermal growth factor receptor 2, a protein on the surface of cells that helps control normal cell growth. It is made from the *ERBB2* gene. Some cancer cells have too much HER2 protein or extra copies of the *ERBB2* gene; these cancers may grow more quickly and spread more easily. Testing HER2 protein levels or gene copies can help classify a cancer and identify whether HER2-targeted treatment may be useful.

HER2-Positive

A cancer whose cells have increased expression or amplification of human epidermal growth factor receptor 2 (HER2). Some HER2-targeted medicines may be used according to the cancer type and clinical context.

HER2-Positive Breast Cancer

Breast cancer cells with unusually high levels of the HER2 growth receptor or extra copies of its gene. This can make the cancer grow faster, but it also allows treatment with medicines that specifically block HER2.

Herbal Supplement

A concentrated plant-derived product marketed for health or symptom relief; composition and evidence vary, and potential risks include contamination, drug interactions, liver injury, and pregnancy effects.

Herbaspirillum

A genus of gram-negative bacteria found in soil and plants; human infection is rare but can occur opportunistically.

Herbicide

A chemical used to kill or control unwanted plants; exposure can irritate skin, eyes, lungs, or the gastrointestinal tract, with toxicity determined by the specific compound and dose.

Herd Immunity

Protection that occurs when enough people in a community are immune to an infection that it spreads less easily. The proportion needed varies widely by infection, and herd immunity does not protect everyone equally.

Hereditary

Transmitted through genetic material from a parent or arising from an inherited variant; a hereditary trait may be dominant, recessive, X-linked, mitochondrial, or multifactorial.

Hereditary Amyloidosis

A group of inherited disorders in which mutations cause misfolded proteins to form amyloid deposits in organs such as the nerves, heart, kidneys, or gastrointestinal tract.

Hereditary and Acquired Ichthyosis Vulgaris

Ichthyosis vulgaris is a scaling disorder that may be inherited, commonly related to filaggrin deficiency, or acquired with systemic disease, medicines, or nutritional problems. It produces dry fish-like scale that is often worse on the limbs and improves with moisturizers and keratolytics.

Hereditary Angioedema

An inherited, usually autosomal dominant and bradykinin-mediated disorder causing repeated episodes of swelling in the skin, hands, feet, stomach or bowel wall, or throat. Types 1 and 2 commonly result from deficiency or dysfunction of C1 inhibitor, often due to variants in the *SERPING1* gene; other forms may have normal C1-inhibitor levels. Attacks may cause severe abdominal pain or swelling that narrows the upper airway and often occur without itchy hives.

Hereditary Cancer

Cancer occurring because a person inherited a disease-causing genetic variant that raises cancer risk. Genetic counseling and risk-based screening can inform prevention and early detection.

Hereditary Coproporphyria

An inherited disorder of a chemical pathway used to make heme, the oxygen-carrying part of hemoglobin. Attacks may cause severe abdominal pain, vomiting, nerve or mental symptoms, and sometimes blistering skin after sunlight exposure.

Hereditary Diffuse Gastric Cancer

An inherited condition, often caused by a harmful CDH1 gene change, that greatly increases the risk of a hard-to-detect stomach cancer and also raises the risk of lobular breast cancer. Risk management can include genetic counseling, specialist screening, and risk-reducing stomach surgery.

Alternate Names:
HDGC; Familial Gastric Cancer Syndrome

Hereditary Diseases

Alternate name; see *Inherited Disease*.

Hereditary Elliptocytosis

An inherited red-cell membrane disorder in which erythrocytes are elliptical on the blood smear; most people are asymptomatic, but hemolytic anemia can occur in severe forms.

Hereditary Fructose Intolerance

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly break down fructose, a sugar in fruit, honey, and table sugar. Eating it can cause vomiting, sweating, low blood glucose, abdominal pain, or liver injury.

Hereditary Hemochromatosis

An inherited disorder that makes the body absorb too much iron from food. Iron can build up in the liver, heart, pancreas, joints, and other organs and cause damage. The most common form is linked to changes in the HFE gene, but not everyone with these changes develops iron overload.

Hereditary Hemorrhagic Telangiectasia

An inherited disorder in which fragile, abnormal blood vessels form in the nose, skin, lungs, brain, or liver. Recurrent nosebleeds and anemia are common; bleeding or abnormal vessels in internal organs may be serious.

Alternate Names:
HHT; Osler-Weber-Rendu Syndrome

Hereditary Hyperbilirubinemia

An inherited disorder of bilirubin production, conjugation, or excretion that causes persistent or intermittent jaundice, such as Gilbert, Crigler–Najjar, Dubin–Johnson, or Rotor syndrome.

Hereditary Leiomyomatosis And Renal Cell Cancer

An inherited condition that can cause painful skin muscle tumors, early or multiple uterine fibroids, and an aggressive type of kidney cancer. It is usually related to an FH gene change; genetic counseling and regular specialist skin, uterine, and kidney assessment are important.

Alternate Names:
HLRCC; Reed Syndrome

Hereditary Motor and Sensory Neuropathy

Alternate name; see *Charcot-Marie-Tooth Disease*.

Hereditary Multiple Exostoses

An inherited disorder in which many benign, cartilage-capped bone growths called osteochondromas form near the ends of growing bones. They usually develop during childhood or adolescence and stop forming when skeletal growth ends. They may cause pain, limited joint movement, unequal limb lengths, short stature, bone deformity, or pressure on nearby nerves and blood vessels. The condition is usually caused by a change in the *EXT1* or *EXT2* gene and follows an autosomal dominant inheritance pattern. Most growths remain benign, but a small number can change into a cancerous cartilage tumor. Also called hereditary multiple osteochondromas.

Alternate Names:
Hereditary Multiple Osteochondromas; Diaphyseal Aclasis

Hereditary Neuropathy with Liability to Pressure Palsies

A usually autosomal dominant peripheral neuropathy caused by pathogenic variants in *PMP22*. About 80% of affected people have a recurrent 1.5-megabase deletion on chromosome 17p11.2; others have sequence variants. It causes recurrent focal numbness or weakness after pressure on a nerve. Nerve biopsy may show tomacula but is not required for diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
HNPP; Pressure Palsy Neuropathy

Hereditary Nonpolyposis Colorectal Cancer (Lynch Syndrome)

An inherited cancer-predisposition syndrome usually caused by impaired DNA mismatch repair. It increases the risk of colorectal, endometrial, ovarian, gastric, urinary-tract, and other cancers; genetic counseling and risk-based surveillance are important.

Hereditary Nonspherocytic Hemolytic Anemia (HNHA)

An inherited hemolytic anemia in which red blood cells are destroyed without the spherical shape typical of hereditary spherocytosis. Causes include red-cell enzyme defects, membrane disorders, and hemoglobin abnormalities; severity varies by the underlying genetic defect.

Hereditary Ovalocytosis

An inherited red-cell membrane disorder in which many erythrocytes are oval or elliptical; it is often mild but can cause hemolytic anemia in some individuals.

Hereditary Paraganglioma-Pheochromocytoma Syndrome

An inherited condition that increases the risk of tumors arising from nerve-related cells near blood vessels or in the adrenal glands. Some tumors release hormones that cause high blood pressure, headache, sweating, or palpitations; genetic counseling and lifelong imaging and hormone monitoring may be needed.

Alternate Names:
Hereditary Paraganglioma; SDH-Associated Pheochromocytoma

Hereditary Periodic Fever Syndromes

A group of inherited autoinflammatory disorders causing recurrent episodes of fever and inflammation without a usual infection. Examples include familial Mediterranean fever, tumor-necrosis-factor-receptor-associated periodic syndrome, mevalonate kinase deficiency, and cryopyrin-associated periodic syndromes.

Hereditary Persistence of Fetal Hemoglobin

An inherited condition in which production of fetal hemoglobin continues into adulthood. It is usually harmless and may lessen the severity of some beta-globin disorders such as sickle-cell disease.

Hereditary Spastic Paraplegia

A group of inherited neurologic disorders causing progressive stiffness and weakness of the legs because of corticospinal-tract degeneration. Some forms also affect speech, vision, sensation, coordination, or other organs.

Hereditary Spherocytic Anemia

An inherited red-cell membrane disorder, usually hereditary spherocytosis, in which fragile spherical erythrocytes are destroyed prematurely, causing hemolytic anemia, jaundice, and splenomegaly.

Hereditary Spherocytosis

Usually an autosomal dominant inherited blood disorder in which red blood cells are round rather than disc-shaped and are broken down too quickly, mainly in the spleen; less often it is autosomal recessive. It may cause anemia, jaundice, gallstones, and an enlarged spleen.

Hereditary Urea Cycle Abnormality

An inherited problem removing ammonia, a waste product, from the blood. Ammonia can build up and cause vomiting, sleepiness, confusion, seizures, coma, and brain injury, especially during illness or fasting.

Heredity

The passing of genetic characteristics from parents to children through genes and chromosomes. Heredity influences appearance, body function, disease risk, medicine response, and susceptibility to some inherited conditions.

Heredo-Ataxia

An inherited disorder causing gradually worsening problems with balance, walking, coordination, or speech. Different gene changes cause different forms, so diagnosis usually includes neurologic assessment and genetic testing.

Heredopolyneuritis

An inherited disorder affecting many peripheral nerves. It may cause gradually worsening weakness, muscle wasting, numbness, reduced reflexes, or difficulty walking, often beginning in the feet and lower legs.

Hering-Breuer Reflex

An automatic lung response that slows or stops breathing in when the lungs are stretched too much. It helps protect the lungs from overinflation, especially during large breaths.

Hermanski-Pudlak Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Hermansky-Pudlak Syndrome*.

Hermansky-Pudlak Syndrome

A group of inherited disorders that can cause reduced skin, hair, and eye pigment; easy bleeding because platelets do not work normally; and, in some types, lung scarring, bowel inflammation, or low white-cell counts. Genetic and specialized blood testing help confirm the diagnosis.

Hernia

A bulge formed when an organ or tissue pushes through a weak area in the muscle or connective tissue that normally holds it in place. Hernias commonly occur in the abdominal wall and may become trapped or lose their blood supply, causing severe pain.

Hernia Mesh

A sheet of synthetic or biologic material used to strengthen the body wall during some hernia repairs. It may reduce recurrence, but complications can include infection, persistent pain, movement of the mesh, or another hernia.

Hernia Repair

Surgery that returns the displaced tissue to its proper place and closes or strengthens the weak area in the body wall. Repair may use stitches, mesh, or a minimally invasive approach; the choice depends on the hernia and the person's health.

Alternate Names:
Herniorrhaphy; Hernioplasty

Herniated Disc

A spinal disk that bulges or tears so that its inner material irritates or presses on a nearby nerve. It can cause back or neck pain, pain spreading into an arm or leg, numbness, tingling, or weakness.

Herniated Disk

Displacement of disk material through a tear in the outer ring of an intervertebral disc, most commonly in the lumbar spine (often at L4-L5 and L5-S1) or the cervical spine, which may press on a nearby nerve and cause pain, numbness, tingling, or weakness.

Herniation

Protrusion of an organ, tissue, or structure through an abnormal opening or weak area, as in a herniated disk or abdominal-wall hernia.

Herniorrhaphy

Alternate term; see *Hernia Repair*.

Heroin

A highly addictive opioid that is converted to morphine in the body. Repeated use can cause opioid dependence, tolerance, and withdrawal; excessive exposure can cause opioid overdose with respiratory depression, coma, and death.

Heroin Toxicity

Opioid poisoning characterized by marked drowsiness or coma, pinpoint pupils, slow or absent breathing, hypoxia, and sometimes noncardiogenic pulmonary edema. Naloxone is used to reverse opioid effects, but recurrent respiratory depression can occur because the opioid effect may outlast a naloxone dose.

Herpangina

A common childhood viral illness causing fever, sore throat, and small blisters or ulcers at the back of the mouth. It spreads through respiratory or stool-contaminated secretions and usually improves on its own.

Herpes

Infection caused by a herpesvirus. The term commonly refers to herpes simplex infection, which causes oral or genital lesions, but other herpesviruses cause distinct diseases.

Herpes Encephalitis

Alternate name; see *Herpes Simplex Encephalitis*.

Herpes Gestationis

An older name for pemphigoid gestationis, an uncommon autoimmune blistering rash of pregnancy. It usually causes intensely itchy hives followed by blisters around the abdomen and may recur in later pregnancies.

Herpes Labialis

Alternate name; see *Cold Sore*.

Herpes Simplex

Infection with herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) or type 2 (HSV-2). HSV-1 most often causes oral herpes or cold sores, while HSV-2 most often causes genital herpes, although either type can infect either site. Many infections cause no symptoms; when symptoms occur, painful blisters or ulcers may appear and recur. The virus remains inactive in nerve cells and can reactivate later. It spreads mainly through skin-to-skin or oral contact, including when no sore is visible, and rarely passes from a parent to a baby during delivery. Rare complications include eye infection, brain infection, or severe infection in a newborn or a person with weakened immunity.

Herpes Simplex Encephalitis

A life-threatening brain infection caused most often by herpes simplex virus type 1. It can cause fever, headache, confusion, seizures, behavior changes, or loss of consciousness; treatment uses antiviral medicine.

Herpes Simplex Infection

A viral infection caused by herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) or type 2 (HSV-2). HSV-1 usually causes oral herpes, while HSV-2 usually causes genital herpes, but either type can affect the mouth or genitals. Many infections are symptom-free; painful blisters or ulcers may develop and return because the virus remains inactive in nerve cells and can reactivate. HSV spreads mainly through oral or skin-to-skin contact, including contact with skin that looks normal. Rare complications include infection

of the eye or brain and severe infection in newborns or people with weakened immunity.

Alternate Names:
HSV Infection

Herpes Simplex Keratitis

Infection or inflammation of the cornea caused by herpes simplex virus, usually producing eye pain, redness, tearing, light sensitivity, or blurred vision. Recurrent disease can scar the cornea and impair sight.

Herpes Simplex Skin Infection

A herpes simplex infection of the skin or moist body linings that causes grouped blisters or shallow sores, often around the mouth or genitals. Widespread infection in someone with eczema can be severe.

Herpes Simplex Type 1

HSV-1, a DNA virus commonly causing oral or perioral blisters; it can also cause genital infection and remains latent with possible recurrence.

Herpes Simplex Virus

A double-stranded DNA virus belonging to the Herpesviridae family that causes oral and genital herpes. HSV has two serotypes: HSV-1, which typically causes oral herpes, and HSV-2, which typically causes genital herpes. The virus establishes latent infections in sensory ganglia and can reactivate periodically.

Herpes Simplex Virus Infection

Alternate name; see *Herpes Simplex Infection*.

Herpes Vegetans

A rare long-lasting herpes simplex infection that causes thick, wart-like or ulcerated growths, usually on genital or anal skin. It occurs mainly in people with weakened immunity and may be difficult to treat.

Herpes Viral Culture Of Lesion

A laboratory culture of fluid or tissue from a lesion to detect herpes simplex virus or varicella-zoster virus; molecular testing is generally more sensitive and is often preferred.

Herpesviridae

A family of DNA viruses that can remain inactive in the body after infection and reactivate later. Human members include herpes simplex viruses, varicella-zoster virus, cytomegalovirus, Epstein–Barr virus, and human herpesviruses 6, 7, and 8. They can cause skin or mouth lesions, chickenpox, shingles, glandular fever, congenital infection, or disease in people with weakened immunity.

Herpesviridae Infection

An infection caused by a herpesvirus; symptoms range from localized lesions to serious disease in newborns or people with weakened immunity.

Herpes Zoster

Reactivation of latent varicella-zoster virus in a sensory ganglion, causing a painful, blistering rash usually confined to one side of the body in one or two adjacent dermatomes. Pain, itching, or tingling may precede the rash; persistent nerve pain afterward is called postherpetic neuralgia.

Alternate Names:
Zoster; Acute Posterior Ganglionitis

Herpes Zoster Infection

Alternate name; see *Herpes Zoster*.

Herpes Zoster Ophthalmicus

Shingles affecting the forehead, eyelid, or nose near the eye. It can involve the cornea or other eye structures and cause inflammation, scarring, or vision loss.

Herpetic Gingivostomatitis

The classic and most common manifestation of primary herpes simplex virus type 1 (HSV-1) infection in infants and young children aged 6 months to 5 years. It is characterized by high fever, irritability, painful submandibular and cervical lymphadenopathy, and widespread friable, inflamed gums with clusters of painful vesicles that rupture into shallow, coalescing ulcers across the buccal mucosa, tongue,

and lips, often severely impairing oral intake.

Alternate Names:
Primary Herpetic Gingivostomatitis; Oral HSV-1 Stomatitis

Herpetic Glossitis

Painful inflammation and sores of the tongue caused by herpes simplex virus. It may occur with blisters or ulcers elsewhere in the mouth and can be more severe or persistent in people with weakened immunity.

Herpetic Keratitis

A herpes simplex infection of the clear front surface of the eye. It may cause one-sided eye pain, redness, light sensitivity, tearing, or blurred vision. A branching ulcer seen with a special dye supports the diagnosis; repeated or deep infection can scar the cornea and damage vision.

Alternate Names:
Herpes Simplex Corneal Infection

Herpetic Stomatitis

Inflammation and ulceration of the mouth caused by herpes simplex virus, most commonly primary HSV-1 infection, with painful vesicles or ulcers and sometimes fever or gingivitis.

Herpetic Whitlow

A painful herpes simplex infection of a finger, causing redness, swelling, and grouped blisters. Incision can spread the virus into surrounding tissues.

Herpetiform

Resembling herpes lesions, typically describing grouped vesicles or an arrangement of lesions; the term does not by itself establish herpesvirus infection.

Herring Bodies

Microscopic dilations and neurosecretory terminal swellings of unmyelinated axons within the posterior lobe of the pituitary gland (neurohypophysis) that store oxytocin and antidiuretic hormone (vasopressin) bound to neurophysin carrier proteins.

Alternate Names:
Neurosecretory Bodies; Neurohypophyseal Axonal Swellings

Hertel Exophthalmometer

An optical instrument used to measure the anterior-posterior distance between the lateral orbital rim and the corneal apex to quantify proptosis or exophthalmos.

Hertz

A unit used to measure frequency, equal to one complete cycle or repetition per second. It is used for sound, electrical signals, brain waves, heart signals, and other repeating events.

Herxheimer Reaction

A temporary worsening of fever, chills, headache, muscle aches, or other symptoms soon after antibiotics begin for some infections, especially syphilis. It usually settles within a day and is caused by the body's response to dying bacteria.

Hesitancy

Alternate name; see *Urinary Hesitation*.

Hesitation Wounds

Multiple superficial, tentative parallel incised cuts surrounding a deeper primary fatal cut wound, classically observed in suicides involving sharp instruments (wrists, neck).

Hesselbach Triangle

A naturally weaker area of the lower front abdominal wall. Direct groin hernias can push through this area, which lies between a central abdominal muscle, blood vessels, and the groin ligament.

Heterochromatin

DNA that is tightly packed inside a cell's nucleus and is usually less active in making proteins. It helps organize chromosomes and control which genes are available for use.

Heterochromia

A difference in iris color between the eyes or within one iris, which may be congenital or acquired from disease, trauma, medication, or inflammation.

Heterocyclic Amine

A nitrogen-containing chemical compound formed mainly when meat or fish is cooked at high temperatures; several heterocyclic amines are mutagens and potential dietary carcinogens.

Heterogeneity

Variation in composition, structure, or behavior within a tissue, sample, lesion, or population; in tumors, heterogeneity can affect biopsy interpretation and treatment response.

Heterogeneous Echotexture

An ultrasound appearance in which different parts of a tissue look unlike one another. It is a finding, not a diagnosis, and may result from inflammation, scarring, fat, bleeding, a tumor, or normal variation.

Heterograft

Alternate name; see *Xenograft*.

Alternate Names:
Heterologous Graft; Xenotransplant; Heteroplastic Graft

Heterologous

Coming from a different species, source, or type. In medicine, the term may describe a graft, tissue, antibody, hormone, or genetic material obtained from a different organism or cell type.

Heterophil Antibody

A heterophil antibody reacts with antigens from unrelated animal species; testing for these antibodies can help diagnose some infections, including infectious mononucleosis.

Heterophile Antibody

A heterophile antibody is an antibody that reacts with antigens from unrelated species and can interfere with some laboratory immunoassays.

Heterophyes Heterophyes

A small intestinal fluke acquired by eating raw or undercooked fish; it can cause abdominal symptoms and occasionally tissue complications.

Heteroplasia

Development of tissue in an abnormal location or of a type not normally found there. The effects depend on the tissue involved and may range from no symptoms to obstruction, pain, or impaired function.

Heteroplasmy

The presence of more than one type of mitochondrial DNA in a cell or person, usually a mixture of normal and changed copies. The proportion of changed copies can influence whether disease develops and how severe it is.

Heterosexual

Describing a person who experiences sexual or romantic attraction mainly toward people of a different sex or gender. Sexual orientation is distinct from gender identity and is not a disease or disorder.

Heterotaxy Syndrome

A birth condition in which organs in the chest and abdomen are arranged differently from usual. Heart defects, abnormal spleen function, and problems with the intestines or other organs may occur.

Heterotopic

Located in an abnormal or unusual place; a heterotopic pregnancy is simultaneous implantation outside the uterus and, usually, inside the uterus.

Heterotopic Ossification

Formation of bone in soft tissue where bone does not normally grow, often after injury, surgery, or damage to the nervous system. It may cause pain or limit movement near the affected joint.

Heterotopic Breast Tissue Of The Vulva

Breast-like glandular tissue located in the vulva outside the normal breast. It may respond to hormonal changes and develop benign lesions, inflammation,

or rarely malignancy; histopathologic examination may be needed for diagnosis.

Heterotopic Pregnancy

A pregnancy in which one embryo implants inside the uterus while another implants outside it, usually in a fallopian tube. It is uncommon but more likely after fertility treatment; an intrauterine pregnancy does not rule out an ectopic pregnancy.

Heterotransplant

A transplant of cells, tissue, or an organ between members of different species. Because the immune difference is substantial, rejection is a major concern and long-term use requires specialized treatment.

Heterozygote

A heterozygote has two different alleles at a genetic locus, one inherited from each parent; phenotype depends on dominance, the variant's effect, and the surrounding genetic and environmental context.

Heterozygous

Having two different alleles of a particular gene at a genetic locus. The observable effect depends on the gene and the relationship between the alleles.

Hexachlorobenzene

A persistent organochlorine compound that can cause porphyria, liver injury, neurologic effects, and other toxicity after significant exposure.

Hexachlorophane

An antibacterial chemical formerly used in some skin cleansers. Repeated or extensive exposure can damage the nervous system, especially in infants, so its medical use is highly restricted.

Hexachlorophene

A topical antiseptic phenolic compound whose excessive or prolonged use can cause neurotoxicity and skin injury; many uses are restricted.

Hexadactyly

The presence of six fingers or six toes on a hand or foot, also called polydactyly.

Hexadecadienoic Acid

A long-chain fatty acid containing 16 carbon atoms and two double bonds, occurring in lipid metabolism and studied as a biochemical or signaling molecule.

Hexadecatetraenoic Acid

A 16-carbon polyunsaturated fatty acid containing four double bonds, present in lipid pathways and investigated for effects on membranes and signaling.

Hexamethonium

An older medicine that blocks nerve signals at autonomic ganglia and can lower blood pressure. It is rarely used because it also causes blurred vision, dry mouth, constipation, urinary retention, and other widespread effects.

Hexamine

A chemical used in industry and, in some settings, as methenamine, a urinary antiseptic. It releases formaldehyde in acidic urine and is unsuitable for some kidney or liver conditions.

Hexane

A solvent found in some industrial products and glue. Long-term inhalation can damage peripheral nerves, causing numbness, weakness, and difficulty walking; swallowing or heavy exposure can also injure the lungs and brain.

Hexanoic Acid

A six-carbon saturated fatty acid, also called caproic acid, found in some fats and odors and used in chemical synthesis; concentrated exposure irritates skin and mucosa.

Hexokinase

An enzyme that begins the use of glucose by adding a phosphate group to it inside cells. This traps glucose in the cell and allows it to enter energy-producing or storage pathways. Most tissues use hexokinase; the liver also uses a related enzyme called glucokinase.

Hexose

A six-carbon monosaccharide, such as glucose, fructose, or galactose, that serves as an energy substrate or metabolic intermediate.

Hexose Monophosphate Shunt

An alternative biochemical pathway used by cells alongside glycolysis to break down glucose. It serves two vital functions: producing NADPH (a chemical compound that protects red blood cells from oxidative damage and aids in building fats) and generating ribose-5-phosphate (a sugar needed to make DNA and RNA).

Alternate Names:
Pentose Phosphate Pathway; PPP

Hexylresorcinol

A phenolic antiseptic and local anesthetic used in some throat lozenges and topical products; excessive use or allergy can cause adverse effects.

Heyde Syndrome

A condition linking narrowing of the aortic valve, an acquired problem with von Willebrand factor (a blood-clotting protein), and bleeding from fragile blood vessels in the digestive tract. The clotting problem can make this bleeding more likely.

Alternate Names:
Heyde's Syndrome; Aortic Stenosis and Angiodysplasia Triad

Heyde Syndrome Triad

Alternate name; see *Heyde Syndrome*.

HHT

Abbreviation; see *Hereditary Hemorrhagic Telangiectasia*.

Hiatal

Relating to a hiatus, an opening or passage in an anatomical structure; a hiatal hernia occurs when abdominal tissue passes through the diaphragm's esophageal hiatus.

Hiatal Hernia

Protrusion of part of the stomach through the esophageal opening in the diaphragm into the chest. It may be sliding or paraesophageal and can be associated with reflux or other symptoms.

Hiatus

A natural opening or passage in a body structure. For example, the diaphragm has an opening through which the esophagus passes; tissue can sometimes bulge through such an opening.

Hiatus Hernia

Another term for hiatal hernia: protrusion of part of the stomach through the esophageal hiatus of the diaphragm into the chest. It may be sliding or paraesophageal.

Hib

Haemophilus influenzae type b, a bacterium that can cause serious infections such as meningitis, pneumonia, bloodstream infection, and swelling of the throat. Routine vaccination greatly reduces these infections in children.

Hibernoma

A rare benign tumor of brown fat, usually a slow-growing painless soft-tissue mass that may feel warm because of its high metabolic and vascular activity.

Hiccough

Alternate spelling; see *Hiccups*.

Hiccup

Singular form; see *Hiccups*.

Hiccups

Sudden tightening of the diaphragm, the muscle under the lungs. Each tightening briefly closes the voice opening and makes the familiar hiccup sound. Hiccups usually stop on their own; those that last a long time may be linked to illness or medicines.

Hidradenitis

A term for inflammation involving sweat glands;

it appears in the names of several skin disorders, including hidradenitis suppurativa and neutrophilic eccrine hidradenitis.

Hidradenitis Suppurativa

A chronic inflammatory disease of hair follicles, usually affecting the armpits, groin, buttocks, and skin beneath the breasts. Recurrent painful nodules and abscesses may progress to draining tunnels and scars. It is noncontagious; despite its name, it is primarily a follicular disorder, not a sweat-gland infection.

Hidradenocarcinoma

A rare malignant sweat-gland tumor that may arise de novo or from a hidradenoma, presenting as a firm nodule and capable of local recurrence and metastasis.

Hidradenoma

A usually harmless tumor arising from sweat-gland cells, typically appearing as a single slow-growing skin lump. It may be flesh-colored, red, cyst-like, or ulcerated, so examination or removal may be needed to distinguish it from other tumors.

Hidradenoma Papilliferum

A benign papillary tumor of apocrine or mammary-like glands, usually presenting as a solitary flesh-colored or red nodule in the vulvar or anogenital region.

Hidrocystoma

A benign cyst of a sweat gland near the eyelid or skin, appearing as a small translucent or bluish papule that may enlarge with heat or sweating.

Hidrosis

Sweating or perspiration; abnormal hidrosis may mean excessive sweating, reduced sweating, or sweating in an unusual pattern.

High Altitude

Elevation high enough that reduced atmospheric pressure lowers available oxygen, commonly beginning around 2,500 meters and increasing the risk of altitude illness.

High Altitude Cerebral Edema

Alternate spelling; see *High-Altitude Cerebral Edema*.

High-Altitude Cerebral Edema

A severe form of altitude illness in which the brain is affected, usually after rapid ascent to high elevation. It can cause confusion, unusual sleepiness, poor coordination, or loss of consciousness and may progress quickly to coma. It is a life-threatening emergency.

Alternate Names:
HACE; Mal de Montagne Cerebral

High Altitude Illness

Health problems caused by traveling to high elevation before the body adapts to lower oxygen levels. Symptoms range from headache and nausea to dangerous brain or lung swelling requiring immediate descent.

High-Altitude Pulmonary Edema

A life-threatening buildup of fluid in the lungs after rapid travel to high altitude. It can cause breathlessness, cough, weakness, and sometimes pink or frothy sputum, and may progress to respiratory failure.

Alternate Names:
HAPE; High Altitude Pulmonary Edema

High Arch

An unusually high curve along the inside of the foot. It may run in families or result from a nerve or muscle disorder and can cause pain, calluses, ankle instability, or difficulty finding comfortable shoes.

Alternate Names:
Pes Cavus; High-Arched Foot; Cavus Foot

High Blood Cholesterol Levels

Too much cholesterol in the blood, especially LDL cholesterol, which can build up in artery walls and increase the risk of heart attack and stroke. It usually causes no symptoms and is found with a blood test.

High Blood Potassium

Elevated potassium concentration in the bloodstream; see *Hyperkalemia*.

High Blood Pressure

Lay term; see *Hypertension*.

High Blood Pressure And Eye Disease

Long-standing high blood pressure can damage retinal blood vessels and the optic nerve, causing hypertensive retinopathy or vision loss.

High Blood Pressure (Hypertension)

Alternate name; see *Hypertension*.

High Blood Protein

An abnormally increased concentration of proteins in the blood, which may result from dehydration, inflammation, infection, or a plasma-cell disorder.

High Blood Sugar

Hyperglycemia, an abnormally elevated concentration of glucose in the blood; persistent hyperglycemia is commonly associated with diabetes but can have other causes.

High Cholesterol

An abnormally high level of cholesterol in the blood, especially low-density lipoprotein cholesterol. It often causes no symptoms but can contribute to plaque buildup in the arteries and cardiovascular disease.

High-Density Lipoprotein

A particle that carries cholesterol through the blood. Often called "HDL cholesterol," its level is one part of heart-risk assessment and does not by itself determine whether someone will have heart disease.

High-Density Lipoprotein Cholesterol

Cholesterol carried in high-density lipoprotein particles, often called HDL cholesterol. Its level is measured as part of a lipid panel and is only one part of cardiovascular risk assessment.

Alternate Names:

HDL-C

High-Dependency Unit

A hospital area for people who need closer observation and more treatment than a general ward provides but do not need the full support of an intensive-care unit. Staff monitor vital signs frequently and provide specialized care.

High-Fiber Foods

Foods rich in soluble or insoluble dietary fiber, including legumes, whole grains, vegetables, fruit, nuts, and seeds, support bowel regularity and may improve cholesterol and glucose control when increased with adequate fluid.

High-Flow Nasal Cannula

A device that delivers warmed, moist oxygen through small tubes in the nose at a high flow rate. It can improve breathing and oxygen levels in people with serious lung illness and is also used after removal of a breathing tube.

High-Fructose Corn Syrup

A liquid sweetener containing varying proportions of glucose and fructose, used in many processed foods and drinks. Like other added sugars, high intake increases total energy exposure and is associated with dental caries and cardiometabolic risk; it is not inherently unique in effect compared with equivalent added sugars.

High-Grade Endometrial Stromal Sarcoma

An aggressive cancer arising from supporting tissue in the uterus. It can grow into the uterine wall, blood vessels, or distant organs and requires specialist treatment based on its extent and cell features.

High-Grade Serous Ovarian Carcinoma

An aggressive cancer involving the ovary, fallopian tube, or nearby lining of the abdomen. It often spreads before causing clear symptoms and may cause bloating, abdominal pain, or changes in bowel or bladder habits.

High-Grade Surface Osteosarcoma

An aggressive bone cancer that starts on the outer surface of a bone. It may cause pain or swelling and can spread to the lungs or other sites, so treatment usually requires specialist cancer care.

High HDL Cholesterol (Hyperalphalipoproteinemia)

An unusually high concentration of high-density lipoprotein cholesterol, caused by genetic traits, medicines, or other conditions. Its effect on cardiovascular risk depends on the underlying cause and the person's complete lipid profile.

High Hemoglobin Count

A hemoglobin level above the expected range, which may reflect dehydration, chronic low oxygen, smoking, medication effects, or a blood disorder.

High-Intensity Focused Ultrasound

A treatment that concentrates sound-wave energy to heat and destroy a selected area of tissue while limiting damage nearby. Uses include some tumors and other conditions, depending on the device and treatment site.

High-Level Disinfection

A cleaning process that kills nearly all microorganisms but may not destroy large numbers of bacterial spores. It is used for some reusable medical equipment that touches moist body surfaces and cannot be heat-sterilized.

Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza

Highly pathogenic influenza A infection in birds that can cause severe disease and mortality in poultry; selected strains can rarely infect humans after animal exposure.

Highly Selective Vagotomy

A type of vagotomy that cuts the vagus-nerve branches that stimulate acid production in the upper stomach while preserving the branches that help the lower stomach empty.

Alternate Names: Parietal Cell Vagotomy; Proximal Gastric Vagotomy

High Output Failure

Heart failure in which cardiac output may be high but is still insufficient for the body's unusually high metabolic or circulatory demand. Causes include severe anemia, thyrotoxicosis, beriberi, and large arteriovenous fistulas.

High-Output Heart Failure

Heart failure in which cardiac output is higher than usual but does not meet the body's increased needs, often because blood vessels are widely dilated or metabolic demand is high. Causes include severe anemia, thyrotoxicosis, beriberi, and large arteriovenous fistulas.

High-Pitched Cry

An unusually shrill infant cry that can occur with pain, neurologic dysfunction, drug withdrawal, or serious illness and warrants assessment when persistent or accompanied by abnormal behavior or feeding.

High Potassium

Alternate name; see *Hyperkalemia*.

High Potassium Level

Hyperkalemia is an elevated blood potassium concentration that can cause dangerous cardiac conduction abnormalities; confirmation, medication review, kidney assessment, ECG, and urgent treatment depend on level and symptoms.

High Protein Diet

An eating pattern providing more protein than a person's usual or estimated requirement; suitability depends on nutritional needs, kidney and liver function, and the overall diet.

High Red Blood Cell Count

An increased number or concentration of red blood cells in the blood, which may thicken the blood and result from dehydration, low oxygen, smoking, medications, or a bone marrow disorder.

Alternate Names:
Erythrocytosis; Polycythemia

High-Resolution Computed Tomography

A CT scan that uses very thin images and special settings to show fine detail, especially in the lungs. It can help detect scarring, inflammation, widened airways, and small-airway disease, but it uses X-rays.

Alternate Names:
HRCT; High-Resolution Chest CT

High-Risk Pregnancy

A pregnancy complicated by maternal medical conditions, previous obstetric complications, or fetal conditions that increase the likelihood of adverse perinatal or maternal outcomes; see *High-Risk Pregnancy Factors*.

High-Risk Pregnancy Factors

Preexisting maternal medical conditions, obstetric complications, or fetal conditions (such as advanced maternal age, chronic hypertension, gestational diabetes, preeclampsia, or fetal growth restriction) that increase morbidity or mortality for mother or child.

Alternate Names:
Maternal-Fetal Health Risks; High-Risk Gestation; Pregnancy Complication Risk Factors

High-Sensitivity Cardiac Troponin

A blood test that detects very small amounts of proteins released when heart muscle is injured. A raised result can occur with a heart attack or many other illnesses, so clinicians interpret repeated results with symptoms, ECG findings, and other tests.

Alternate Names:
hs-cTn; High-Sensitivity Troponin Assay

High Triglycerides

Alternate name; see *Hypertriglyceridemia*.

High Uric Acid Level

An increased concentration of uric acid in the blood, which may contribute to gout or kidney stones and can result from reduced kidney clearance, diet, medicines, or metabolic disease.

High White Blood Cell Count

An increased number of white blood cells, often associated with infection, inflammation, stress, medicines, or a blood or bone marrow disorder.

Hilar

Relating to a hilum, the gateway where vessels, nerves, ducts, or bronchi enter or leave an organ, especially the lung or kidney.

Hilar Cholangiocarcinoma

A cancer at the place where the liver's main bile ducts join. It can block bile flow and cause yellow skin or eyes, itching, dark urine, pale stools, weight loss, or repeated bile-duct infections.

Hilar Lymphadenopathy

Pathological enlargement of the bronchopulmonary (hilar) lymph nodes located at the hilum of the lungs, identifiable on chest radiography and CT, classically presenting as bilateral symmetrical hilar adenopathy in sarcoidosis or unilateral enlargement in tuberculosis and lung malignancies.

Alternate Names:
Hilar Adenopathy; Bronchopulmonary Lymphadenopathy

Hill-Sachs Lesion

A dent or compression fracture in the back of the upper-arm bone caused when the shoulder dislocates forward, sometimes contributing to repeated dislocations.

Hill's Sign

Hill's sign is an older physical finding described in some cases of aortic regurgitation; it is not sufficient by itself to diagnose the condition.

Hilum

A depression or opening where blood vessels, nerves, ducts, or other structures enter or leave an organ.

Hilus

The hilus is an indentation or entry point on an organ where vessels, nerves, ducts, or airways enter or leave.

Hindbrain

The hindbrain is the lower part of the developing brain, giving rise to the medulla, pons, and cerebellum and helping control vital functions and coordination.

Hindgut

The hindgut is the embryonic part of the digestive tract that forms much of the distal colon, rectum, and upper anal canal.

H Influenzae Meningitis

A serious infection of the coverings of the brain and spinal cord caused by Haemophilus influenzae bacteria. It may cause fever, headache, stiff neck, confusion, seizures, or brain injury, especially in unvaccinated children.

Hinge Joint

A joint that mainly allows bending and straightening in one direction, like a door hinge. The elbow and knee are examples.

HINTS Examination

A bedside eye-movement examination comprising the horizontal head-impulse test, assessment of nystagmus, and test of skew (vertical eye misalignment). It helps distinguish central causes, especially stroke, from peripheral vestibular causes in acute continuous vestibular syndrome with nystagmus. Accuracy depends on appropriate training; HINTS-plus adds bedside hearing assessment.

Hip

The joint and surrounding region where the thigh bone meets the pelvis, allowing movement and bearing body weight.

Hip Arthroscopy

A minimally invasive procedure that uses a camera and instruments inserted through small incisions to diagnose and treat selected disorders inside or around the hip joint.

Hip Bursitis

Hip bursitis is inflammation of a bursa near the hip, commonly causing pain over the outer hip that worsens with lying on that side, stairs, or prolonged walking. Activity changes, physical therapy, medicines, or injection may help after other causes are considered.

Hip Circumference

The measurement around the widest part of the hips or buttocks, used in anthropometry and sometimes combined with waist circumference to assess body-fat distribution.

Hip Dislocation

The ball at the top of the thighbone comes out of the hip socket. It is usually caused by major injury and causes severe pain and inability to move the leg; nearby nerves and the blood supply to the bone may also be injured.

Hip Subluxation

Partial slipping of the ball of the thighbone out of the hip socket. It may result from injury or a problem with joint shape or stability and can cause pain or a feeling that the hip is giving way.

Hip Disorders

The hip joints are ball-and-socket joints connecting the femur to the pelvis, providing stability and a wide range of motion for walking, running, and weight-bearing activities. Common hip conditions include osteoarthritis, fractures, bursitis, and labral tears.

Hip Dysplasia

Alternate name; see *Developmental Dysplasia Of The Hip*.

Hip Fracture

A break in the upper thighbone, commonly near

the femoral neck or just below it. It often follows a fall in someone with fragile bones and causes hip or groin pain, inability to bear weight, and sometimes a shortened or outward-turned leg.

Hip Fracture In Older Adults

A fracture of the upper thighbone in an older person, commonly after a fall or minor force when bone strength is reduced. It can cause pain, loss of mobility, delirium, blood clots, and loss of independence.

Alternate Names:
Geriatric Hip Fracture

Hip-Fracture Rehabilitation

Recovery care after a broken hip that helps restore walking, strength, balance, and independence. It may include early movement, pain control, exercises, nutrition, prevention of blood clots, delirium prevention, and treatment to reduce future fracture risk.

Hip Fracture Surgery

An operation to stabilize or replace a fractured proximal femur, using internal fixation, hemiarthroplasty, or total hip arthroplasty according to fracture pattern and patient factors.

Hip Impingement

A problem in which the ball of the thighbone and rim of the hip socket make abnormal contact during movement, often because of bone-shape differences. These differences may cause no symptoms; when they do, they can cause groin pain or stiffness, especially with deep bending. The contact can damage the labrum or joint cartilage; also called femoroacetabular impingement (FAI).

Alternate Names:
Femoroacetabular Impingement; FAI

Hip Instability

Too much movement or poor control of the hip joint, sometimes causing pain, clicking, or a feeling that the hip may give way. It can be related to joint shape, loose supporting tissues, or injury.

Hip Injury

Damage involving the hip joint, surrounding muscles, tendons, ligaments, or bones; causes range from strain and bursitis to fracture and dislocation, with inability to bear weight requiring prompt assessment.

Hip Joint

The ball-and-socket joint where the top of the thighbone fits into the pelvis. It supports body weight and allows the leg to move in many directions; strong ligaments and a cartilage rim help keep it stable.

Hip Joint Effusion

Extra fluid inside the hip joint. It may occur with injury, inflammation, or infection and can cause pain and reduced movement; see also *Joint Effusion*.

Hip Joint Infection

Alternate name; see *Septic Arthritis*.

Hip Joint Injection

Injection of local anesthetic, corticosteroid, or another prescribed agent into or around the hip joint for diagnosis or temporary relief of pain and inflammation.

Hip Joint Replacement

Arthroplasty replaces damaged parts of the hip with prosthetic components to relieve pain and improve mobility, commonly for advanced osteoarthritis, fracture, or other destructive joint disease.

Hip Labral Tear

A tear in the ring of cartilage surrounding the hip socket. It may cause groin pain, clicking, catching, stiffness, or reduced movement and can result from injury, repeated stress, or abnormal hip shape.

Hip Osteoarthritis

Wear and damage of the smooth cartilage in the hip joint. It can cause groin or thigh pain, stiffness, and difficulty moving the hip, often worse with walking or after resting.

Hip Osteomyelitis

Infection of a bone near the hip joint, such as the pelvis or upper thighbone. It can cause lasting pain and tenderness, sometimes with fever; see also *Osteomyelitis*.

Hip Pain

Pain in or around the hip caused by joint disease, tendon or muscle injury, bursitis, fracture, nerve problems, or pain referred from the back.

Hip Chondral Injury

Damage to the smooth cartilage covering the surfaces inside the hip joint. It may cause pain, catching, or reduced movement and can occur after injury or with other joint problems.

Hip Flexor Strain

An overstretch or small tear in a muscle or tendon that bends the hip, often after a sudden sprint, kick, or other forceful movement. It can cause pain or tenderness at the front of the hip or groin, especially when lifting the knee.

Hip Stress Fracture

A small crack in a bone around the hip, usually the upper thighbone or pelvis, caused by repeated loading. Pain often begins gradually and worsens with activity; femoral-neck stress fractures can be serious.

Hip Synovitis

Inflammation of the thin lining inside the hip joint. It can cause pain and stiffness; temporary hip synovitis is a separate short-term condition seen mainly in children.

Hip Tendinitis

Irritation or inflammation of a tendon around the hip, often after repeated use or strain. It can cause pain and tenderness with movement; the affected tendon determines where symptoms occur. See also *Tendinitis* and *Tendinopathy*.

Hippocampal Sclerosis

Severe selective neuronal cell loss and astrocytic gliosis involving the pyramidal cell layer of the CA1 and CA4 subfields and the dentate gyrus of the hippocampus, representing the most common histopathological finding in medically refractory temporal lobe epilepsy.

Alternate Names:
Mesial Temporal Sclerosis; MTS

Hippocampus

A pair of structures deep in the brain that help form and retrieve new memories and support learning and navigation. Damage to them can cause difficulty forming new memories.

Hippocrates

An ancient Greek physician traditionally regarded as a major founder of Western clinical medicine; the Hippocratic corpus emphasizes observation, prognosis, and professional conduct.

Hippocratic Oath

A traditional promise that doctors make to practice medicine ethically, help patients, protect their privacy, and avoid harm. Modern versions differ by country and institution.

Hippotherapy

A treatment in which a trained therapist uses the movement of a horse to support physical, occupational, or speech therapy. It may help some people improve balance, posture, muscle control, coordination, or communication, but it is tailored to individual goals and safety needs.

Hip Prosthesis

An artificial hip joint used to replace a damaged hip. It usually has a stem placed in the thighbone, a ball, and a socket; parts may be metal, ceramic, or durable plastic and may be fixed with or without bone cement.

Hippus

Hippus is rhythmic, involuntary widening and nar-

rowing of the pupil, which may occur normally or with neurologic or eye disease.

Hip Replacement

A surgical procedure in which the diseased hip joint is replaced with a prosthetic implant (arthroplasty). Total hip replacement (THR) replaces both the femoral head and the acetabulum.

Alternate Names:
Total Hip Replacement; Total Hip Arthroplasty; THR

Hirata Disease

An uncommon autoimmune disorder characterized by recurrent episodes of severe hyperinsulinemic hypoglycemia triggered by high circulating titers of endogenous polyclonal autoantibodies directed against native human insulin. Occurs without prior exogenous insulin therapy, strongly associated with HLA-DR4 alleles and exposure to sulfhydryl-containing medications.

Alternate Names:
Insulin Autoimmune Syndrome; IAS

Hirayama Disease

A condition affecting the lower neck spinal cord, usually in teenage boys and young men. It causes slowly worsening, often one-sided weakness and wasting of the hand and forearm muscles. Neck bending can press the spinal cord and reduce its blood supply. Symptoms commonly stop progressing after several years. A neck MRI taken during bending helps confirm the diagnosis; early neck protection may limit damage.

Alternate Names:
Monomelic Amyotrophy; Juvenile Cervical Flexion Myelopathy

Hirschsprung Disease

A birth defect characterized by missing nerve cells (ganglion cells) in the muscular wall of part or all of the large intestine (colon). Because these missing nerves are required to trigger the rhythmic muscular contractions (peristalsis) that push stool forward, the affected segment of the intestine remains tightly constricted, causing a severe intestinal blockage. Newborns typically fail to pass their first bowel movement (meconium) within the first 48 hours of life, accompanied by severe abdominal swelling and vomiting.

Alternate Names:
Hirschsprung's Disease; Congenital Aganglionic Megacolon

Hirschsprung's Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Hirschsprung Disease*.

Hirsutism

Extra growth of coarse, dark hair on the face, chest, abdomen, or other areas where men usually grow hair. It is often linked to higher levels of male-type hormones, such as in polycystic ovary syndrome, but family traits or medicines can also cause it. Rapid new growth, a deeper voice, or severe acne should be checked by a healthcare professional.

Alternate Names:
Male-Pattern Hair Growth in Women; Androgenic Hair Excess

Hirudin

A potent, 65-amino-acid naturally occurring anticoagulant polypeptide originally isolated from the salivary glands of the European medicinal leech (*Hirudo medicinalis*). Unlike heparin, which requires the plasma cofactor antithrombin III, hirudin functions as a direct, bivalent thrombin inhibitor, binding with extremely high affinity and specificity to both the catalytic active site and the fibrinogen-binding exosite-1 of α-thrombin, completely blocking thrombin-mediated conversion of fibrinogen to fibrin and thrombin-induced platelet activation. Recombinant hirudins (e.g., lepirudin, desirudin) and synthetic hirudin analogues (bivalirudin, a synthetic 20-amino-acid peptide) have been developed for parenteral clinical use, particularly as alternative anticoagulants in patients with heparin-induced thrombocytopenia (HIT) and for procedural anticoagulation during percutaneous coronary intervention (PCI). Monitored via the activated partial thromboplastin time (aPTT) or ecarin clotting time; because hirudin has no specific neutralizing reversal antidote and is cleared renally, it requires careful dosage ad-

justment in renal impairment.

Alternate Names:
Hirudins; Direct Thrombin Inhibitor

Hirudins

Plural form; see *Hirudin*.

Hirudo Medicinalis

The medicinal leech, used in selected medical procedures to relieve venous congestion after reconstructive surgery.

His

Usually referring to the bundle of His, the atrioventricular conduction bundle that carries electrical impulses from the AV node into the right and left bundle branches.

His Bundle Electrography

An invasive electrophysiologic recording of electrical activity in the atrioventricular His bundle, used to assess conduction-system disease and localize atrioventricular block.

Histamine

A chemical messenger made by the body. It helps regulate brain activity, stomach acid, and other body functions. Immune cells release it during allergic reactions, where it can cause itching, redness, swelling, more mucus, and narrowing of the airways.

Histamine Degradation

The body's breakdown and removal of histamine after it has acted. This limits effects such as itching, swelling, airway narrowing, and increased stomach acid.

Histamine Receptor

A protein on or in a cell that responds to histamine. Different receptor types help control allergic symptoms, stomach-acid production, nerve signaling, and immune responses.

Histamine Release

Discharge of histamine from mast cells or basophils during allergic, immune, or nonimmune activation, causing effects such as itching, vasodilation, swelling, mucus production, and bronchoconstriction.

Histidine

Histidine is an amino acid used in protein synthesis and a precursor of histamine; it is essential during growth and can be metabolized to urocanic acid and other products.

Histidine Decarboxylase

An enzyme that converts the amino acid histidine into histamine. It is found in human cells and some microorganisms; histamine influences allergy, stomach acid, blood-vessel responses, and immunity.

Histidinemia

An inherited metabolic disorder caused by reduced histidase activity, leading to elevated histidine in blood and urine; many affected people have few or no clinically important symptoms.

Histiocyte

An immune cell found in tissues that can engulf germs, damaged cells, or foreign material and help alert other immune cells.

Histiocytic Sarcoma

A rare aggressive cancer of cells that normally help process immune signals and foreign material. It may arise in lymph nodes, the intestine, skin, or other organs and requires specialist pathology and cancer care.

Histiocytoma

A tumor name used for different growths and not a single specific diagnosis. In the skin, benign fibrous histiocytoma usually refers to dermatofibroma, a benign nodule. The older term malignant fibrous histiocytoma has been replaced by more specific tumor diagnoses, such as undifferentiated pleomorphic sarcoma.

Histiocytosis

A group of uncommon disorders in which certain

immune cells build up abnormally in the skin, bones, organs, or blood. Effects range from isolated skin or bone problems to serious disease affecting several organs.

Histiocytosis X

Historical name; see *Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis*.

Histochemical

Histochemical means using chemical stains or reactions in tissue sections to identify particular substances or cell components.

Histocompatibility

The degree to which donor and recipient tissues are immunologically alike. Matching tissue markers, especially HLA markers, can lower rejection risk, but antibody testing, organ type, and the recipient's health also influence transplant success.

Histocompatibility Antigen Test

A test identifying human leukocyte antigen types, which influence tissue compatibility for transplantation and are relevant to some immune-mediated and genetic associations.

Histocompatibility Testing

Laboratory typing of HLA and other immune markers to assess donor–recipient compatibility before transplantation and to investigate selected immune or transfusion-related questions.

Histogenesis

The developmental process by which unspecialized cells differentiate and organize into mature tissues with characteristic structures and functions.

Histological Techniques

Laboratory methods for preparing, staining, sectioning, and examining tissue under a microscope to reveal cellular architecture, deposits, organisms, or disease-related changes.

Histology

The study of cells and tissues under a microscope. A laboratory prepares a thin tissue section, applies stains that show its structures, and examines it for normal features or changes caused by disease.

Histology Cassette

A labeled perforated container that holds a tissue specimen during processing, allowing fixation, dehydration, paraffin infiltration, and later embedding for microscopic sectioning.

Histone

A protein around which DNA winds so it can fit inside the cell nucleus. Chemical changes to histones help control which genes are turned on or off.

Histone Acetylation

Addition of acetyl groups to histone proteins that usually loosens DNA packaging and can increase access of transcriptional machinery to genes.

Histone Acetyltransferase

An enzyme that transfers acetyl groups to histone proteins, generally promoting a more open chromatin state and regulating gene transcription.

Histone Deacetylases

Enzymes that remove acetyl groups from histones and other proteins, influencing chromatin structure, gene expression, cell differentiation, and disease biology.

Histone Deacetylation

Removal of acetyl groups from histones, often tightening chromatin and reducing transcription; histone deacetylases are targets of some anticancer drugs.

Histone Modification

A chemical change to a histone protein that alters how tightly DNA is packed and can change which genes a cell uses. These changes help regulate cell growth, development, and response to disease.

Histopathologic Grade

A microscopic estimate of how abnormal and aggressive tumor cells appear compared with their

tissue of origin; grade contributes to prognosis and treatment planning alongside stage.

Histopathology

The diagnosis of disease by examining tissue under a microscope. A pathologist studies a biopsy or surgical specimen for abnormal cells, inflammation, infection, scarring, or cancer.

Histoplasma

A genus of fungi that includes Histoplasma capsulatum, which can cause histoplasmosis after inhalation of environmental spores.

Histoplasma Capsulatum

A fungus found in soil contaminated with bird or bat droppings that can cause histoplasmosis when its spores are inhaled.

Histoplasma Complement Fixation

A blood test that detects complement-fixing antibodies to Histoplasma and can support evaluation of histoplasmosis, although sensitivity, timing, cross-reactions, and immune status affect interpretation.

Histoplasmosis

A fungal infection acquired by breathing in spores from soil contaminated with bird or bat droppings. It often affects the lungs and may be mild, but can spread to other organs, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Histrionic Personality Disorder

A long-term pattern of intense emotional expression, strong need for attention, and behavior that may seem dramatic, suggestible, or uncomfortable when not the focus. Diagnosis requires a persistent pattern that causes significant problems and is made by a qualified mental-health professional.

Hitchhiker's Thumb

A descriptive term for an unusually flexible thumb that can bend backward at the distal joint. It is usually a harmless inherited variation unless associated with pain, instability, or a broader connective-tissue disorder.

HIV

Abbreviation; see *Human Immunodeficiency Virus*.

HIV/AIDS

Alternate term; see *HIV Infection*.

HIV/AIDS Immunopathogenesis

HIV enters and gradually destroys or disables important immune cells. Without treatment, immune defenses become weaker and serious infections or cancers may develop. Medicines stop most viral multiplication and allow immune recovery.

HIV/AIDS In Pregnant Women And Infants

HIV care in pregnancy and infancy uses maternal antiretroviral therapy, viral-load monitoring, delivery and feeding planning, infant prophylaxis, and early infant diagnostic testing to reduce vertical transmission.

HIV/AIDS Nutrition

Nutritional care for people living with HIV or AIDS. Infection, poor appetite, diarrhea, medicine side effects, or other illnesses may cause weight loss or nutrient shortages; care may include food support, supplements, treatment of infections, and review of medicines.

Hiv Antibodies

Proteins made by the immune system after HIV infection and detected by blood or oral-fluid tests. A positive screening result needs confirmatory testing, and a negative result may be unreliable soon after exposure.

HIV-Associated Nephropathy

A severe renal disease occurring predominantly in individuals with advanced, untreated HIV infection. It is pathologically characterized by a collapsing variant of focal segmental glomerulosclerosis with marked podocyte injury and microcystic tubular dilation, typically presenting with heavy

non-nephrotic or nephrotic proteinuria, rapid progression to kidney failure, and normal-to-enlarged echogenic kidneys on renal ultrasound.

Alternate Names:
HIVAN; HIV-Associated Kidney Disease

HIV-Associated Rheumatic Disease

Joint, muscle, bone, or connective-tissue problems associated with HIV infection or its immune effects. They may include inflammatory arthritis, reactive arthritis, muscle disease, osteoporosis, or symptoms related to infection or treatment. Antiretroviral therapy suppresses viral replication and reduces transmission and complications.

Hives

The common term for urticaria, describing raised, intensely itchy welts (wheals) on the skin. They happen when immune cells in the skin release histamine, causing fluid to leak from tiny blood vessels. Individual welts typically appear quickly, change shape, and fade away within 24 hours without leaving a scar. Hives lasting under six weeks are acute, often triggered by viral infections, foods, insect stings, or medications. Hives lasting longer than six weeks are chronic and often occur without a known external trigger.

Alternate Names:
Urticaria; Urticarial Weals

Hives And Angioedema

Hives are raised itchy welts; angioedema is deeper swelling of the skin or mucous membranes, often caused by allergy, medicines, or other immune reactions.

HIV Infection

A chronic infection caused by human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), which attacks CD4 immune cells. Without treatment, it can progress to acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS), defined by a CD4 count below 200 cells/mm^3 or an AIDS-defining illness. Antiretroviral therapy suppresses the virus and can prevent progression.

HIV in Pregnancy

HIV infection during pregnancy can affect maternal health and can be transmitted to the fetus or newborn without effective care. Antiretroviral treatment, viral-load monitoring, obstetric planning, and newborn prophylaxis greatly reduce perinatal transmission; treatment decisions require specialist guidance.

HIV-Related Kidney Disease

Kidney disease associated with HIV infection, its immune effects, or treatment. It may include collapsing focal segmental glomerulosclerosis, immune-complex disease, thrombotic microangiopathy, or drug toxicity; antiretroviral therapy and kidney-protective care are important.

Hiv Seropositivity

The presence of detectable HIV antibodies or other blood-test evidence of infection. A reactive screening test is not final until confirmatory testing is completed.

HIV Test

A blood or oral-fluid test that looks for HIV infection. Laboratory tests may detect viral material or antibodies; a reactive screening result needs confirmatory testing. Tests can be negative early in infection, so repeat testing may be needed after a recent exposure.

HIV Transmission And Prevention

The spread of HIV through infected blood, semen, vaginal fluids, rectal fluids, or breast milk, prevented by testing, treatment that suppresses viral load, condoms, sterile equipment, and pre- or post-exposure prophylaxis.

HIV Viral Load

The amount of HIV genetic material in the blood. It shows how actively HIV is multiplying and whether treatment is working; an "undetectable" result means the amount is below the test's detection limit, not that HIV has been cured.

Alternate Names:
HIV Viral Burden; Quantitative HIV RNA

HLA

A group of cell-surface proteins helping the immune system recognize the body's own cells, reject foreign tissue, and influence transplant compatibility.

Alternate Names:
Human Leukocyte Antigen System; Major Histocompatibility Complex (MHC)

Hla Antigen

A marker on the surface of cells that helps immune cells recognize what belongs to the body. HLA markers are important for matching donors and recipients in transplantation and are linked with risk of some immune diseases.

HLA-B27

An inherited immune-system marker associated with increased risk of some inflammatory conditions affecting the spine, joints, eyes, or bowel. A positive test does not prove that a person has one of these diseases.

HLA-B27 Antigen

A cell-surface immune marker associated with increased risk of ankylosing spondylitis and related spondyloarthritis, reactive arthritis, and uveitis; a positive result is not diagnostic by itself.

HLA System

The HLA system is a group of cell-surface proteins that present antigens to immune cells and influence transplant matching and autoimmune risk.

HLHS

Abbreviation; see *Hypoplastic Left Heart Syndrome*.

Hmgb Proteins

Proteins that help organize genetic material inside cells. When released from damaged cells, some can also signal tissue injury and promote inflammation.

HMG-CoA Reductase

An enzyme the liver uses to make cholesterol. Statin medicines partly lower blood cholesterol by blocking this enzyme.

Hmgn Proteins

Proteins that help control how genetic material is arranged and used inside cells. They can influence cell growth, specialization, and repair of genetic material.

Hoarding

Alternate name; see *Hoarding Disorder*.

Hoarding Disorder

A mental-health condition involving persistent difficulty discarding possessions, even when they have little value. Saving items causes distress and can fill living areas so that normal activities or safety are impaired.

Hoarseness

A change in the voice that makes it rough, weak, breathy, or strained. Common causes include a viral infection, voice overuse, smoking, reflux, or a growth on the vocal folds. Hoarseness lasting more than a few weeks needs assessment.

Hodgkin Lymphoma

A type of blood cancer that begins in the lymphatic system, part of the body's immune network. It is characterized by the presence of large, abnormal cancerous white blood cells called Reed-Sternberg cells within enlarged lymph nodes. Common symptoms include painless swelling of lymph nodes in the neck, armpits, or groin, persistent fatigue, unexplained weight loss, night sweats, and fever.

Alternate Names:
Hodgkin's Lymphoma; Hodgkin Disease; Hodgkin's Disease

Hodgkin Lymphoma In Children

A malignant lymphoma arising from lymphoid tissue in children, characterized by Hodgkin and Reed-Sternberg cells and treated according to subtype, stage, and risk.

Hodgkin's And Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma Comparison

Hodgkin lymphoma is defined by characteristic

Reed-Sternberg cells and commonly spreads in an orderly pattern, while non-Hodgkin lymphomas comprise many B-cell, T-cell, and other lymphoid cancers. Biopsy, immunophenotyping, and staging determine treatment and prognosis.

Hodgkin's Disease

Alternate name; see *Hodgkin Lymphoma*.

Hodgkin's Lymphoma

Alternate name; see *Hodgkin Lymphoma*.

Hoffmann Sign

A reflex test where flicking the middle fingernail makes the thumb and index finger quickly twitch inward, pointing to irritation or pressure on the spinal cord in the neck.

Hoffmann Syndrome

An uncommon form of adult muscle weakness caused by severe, untreated underactive thyroid disease. It may cause stiff or painful muscles, cramps, enlarged-looking muscles, slow reflex relaxation, and high muscle-enzyme levels; treating the thyroid problem usually improves it.

Alternate Names:
Hypothyroid Myopathy with Pseudohypertrophy

Hofmann's Syndrome

A rare form of adult hypothyroid muscle disease causing muscle enlargement, stiffness, cramps, weakness, and slowed reflexes. Treating the low thyroid hormone level usually improves the muscle problems.

Holiday Heart Syndrome

An episode of atrial or other cardiac arrhythmia occurring after heavy or binge alcohol intake, often in someone without known structural heart disease. Atrial fibrillation is the most common presentation.

Holistic Medicine

An approach that considers physical, psychological, social, behavioral, and sometimes spiritual factors in health and illness. Evidence, safety, and compatibility with conventional treatment vary among individual therapies.

Hollenhorst Plaque

A bright, glistening, refractile, golden-orange cholesterol crystal embolus observed on ophthalmoscopic examination lodged at a retinal arterial bifurcation, originating from an ulcerated atheromatous plaque in the ipsilateral carotid artery or aortic arch.

Alternate Names:
Hollenhorst's Plaque; Retinal Cholesterol Embolus

Holmium

A rare-earth metal used in some medical lasers and radioactive tracers. Holmium laser energy can cut or vaporize tissue, especially in urologic procedures; radioactive holmium requires strict handling and safety controls.

Holmium Laser Enucleation Of The Prostate

A procedure performed through the urine passage that uses a laser to separate and remove excess prostate tissue blocking urine flow. The tissue is removed from the bladder and examined; temporary bleeding, burning, leakage, infection, or sexual and urinary changes can occur.

Alternate Names:
HoLEP; Holmium Prostate Enucleation

Holoprosencephaly

A birth difference in which the developing brain does not divide fully into two cerebral hemispheres. Severity varies; it may affect facial development, movement, feeding, seizures, and intellectual development.

Holorachischisis

A severe birth defect in which a long section of the spine and spinal cord fails to close during development. It usually causes major weakness, loss of sensation, and other serious nervous-system problems.

Holosystolic Murmur Differential

A heart murmur heard throughout the period when the heart's lower chambers contract. Common causes include leakage of the mitral or tricuspid valve and a hole between the lower chambers; its sound, location, and other findings help identify the cause.

Holter Electrocardiography

Continuous ambulatory ECG recording, usually for 24 hours or longer, used to detect intermittent arrhythmias, correlate symptoms with rhythm, and assess heart-rate patterns.

Holter Monitor

A small portable recorder that continuously tracks the heart's electrical rhythm, usually for a day or longer. It can detect intermittent abnormal rhythms and compare them with symptoms such as palpitations, dizziness, or fainting.

Holter Monitoring

Portable, continuous electrocardiographic recording over an extended period, commonly 24 hours or longer, to detect intermittent rhythm abnormalities and correlate them with symptoms.

Holt-Oram Syndrome

An inherited condition causing abnormalities of the bones in one or both arms or hands and heart defects. The heart problem may be a hole between chambers or an abnormal rhythm; the severity varies widely.

Homeobox Gene

A gene that helps control how an embryo's body is laid out and how organs and tissues develop. Changes in some homeobox genes can cause birth differences or disease.

Homeodomain Proteins

Transcription factors containing a homeodomain that bind regulatory DNA sequences and direct developmental patterning and cell differentiation.

Homeopathy

An alternative-health system that uses highly diluted preparations selected according to "like cures like"; reliable evidence has not shown homeopathic products to treat serious disease beyond placebo effects.

Homeostasis

The body's ability to keep internal conditions within a safe range despite changes outside it. It regulates temperature, blood sugar, blood pressure, fluid, salts, and acidity through coordinated feedback systems.

Homeotherm

An organism that maintains a relatively stable internal body temperature despite changes in environmental temperature, largely through physiological regulation.

Homicidal Ideation

Thoughts about killing or seriously harming another person. Intent, a specific plan, access to means, or inability to maintain safety indicate an acute risk of harm.

Homicide

The killing of one person by another, classified legally according to intent and circumstances; medical assessment may address injury patterns, cause of death, toxicology, and safeguarding.

Homocysteine

An amino acid formed during methionine metabolism. Persistently elevated blood levels may occur with genetic, nutritional, renal, or other disorders.

Homocysteine Test

A blood test measuring homocysteine, an amino acid intermediate whose elevation may indicate folate or vitamin B12 deficiency or increased vascular risk; see *Homocysteine*.

Homocystinuria

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly process homocysteine, an amino acid. It may cause eye problems, abnormal bones, learning or developmental problems, and an increased risk of blood clots.

Homograft

A transplant of tissue or an organ between two people of the same species but with different genetic makeup. The recipient's immune system may reject it, so matching and immune-suppressing treatment are important.

Homologous

Similar because of a shared origin, structure, or genetic relationship. In medicine, homologous tissue or cells come from the same species, while homologous chromosomes carry corresponding genes.

Homologous Recombination

A DNA-repair and genetic-exchange process that uses a matching or nearly matching sequence as a template to repair breaks or reshuffle genetic material.

Homologous Transplantation

Transplantation of cells, tissue, or an organ between genetically different people of the same species, requiring attention to compatibility, rejection, infection, and immunosuppression.

Homonymous Hemianopia

A visual field deficit characterized by the loss of the same half of the visual field (either both right halves or both left halves) in both eyes. It results from a retrochiasmal lesion affecting the optic tract, lateral geniculate nucleus, optic radiation, or primary visual cortex on the side opposite the visual defect.

Homo Sapiens

The scientific name for modern humans, the living human species with shared biological features, genetic variation, and worldwide populations.

Homosexual

Describing a person who experiences enduring romantic or sexual attraction to people of the same sex; sexual orientation is not a mental disorder.

Homosexuality

Sexual or romantic attraction to people of the same sex or gender; it is not a mental disorder or pathology.

Homovanillic Acid

A breakdown product of dopamine found in cerebrospinal fluid, blood, and urine; levels may reflect dopamine metabolism but are interpreted cautiously because many factors affect them.

Homozygote

An individual or cell carrying two identical alleles at a particular gene locus, whether the alleles are normal, pathogenic, or another variant.

Homozygous

Having two copies of the same version of a gene, one inherited from each parent. The effect depends on the gene and whether that version is harmless, protective, or disease-causing.

Homozygous Alpha-1-Antitrypsin Deficiency

Severe inherited alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency caused by disease-associated variants in both gene copies, increasing risk of early emphysema and liver disease; see *Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency*.

Homozygous Familial Hypercholesterolemia

Severe familial hypercholesterolemia caused by pathogenic variants affecting both copies of a relevant lipid-clearance gene; LDL cholesterol can be extremely high and atherosclerotic disease may occur early.

Honey-Bee Stings

Injuries caused by a honey-bee injecting venom into the skin. A sting usually causes local pain, redness,

and swelling; a severe allergic reaction can cause breathing difficulty, fainting, or shock and requires emergency treatment.

Honeycomb Lung

The characteristic advanced radiographic and histopathological pattern of end-stage diffuse pulmonary fibrosis, consisting of cystic air spaces (3 to 10 mm in diameter) bounded by thickened fibrotic walls, classic for usual interstitial pneumonia (UIP) and idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis.

Alternate Names:
Honeycombing; Pulmonary Honeycombing

Honeycomb Lung Pathology

End-stage fibrotic remodeling with multiple irregular cystic airspaces, often subpleural and lined by bronchiolar-type epithelium, accompanied by architectural distortion and interstitial fibrosis.

Honolulu Fever

An infection caused by Streptobacillus bacteria, usually after contact with rats or contaminated food. It may cause fever, vomiting, headache, muscle or joint pain, and a rash; treatment uses antibiotics.

Hookworm

An intestinal infection caused by parasitic worms whose larvae live in contaminated soil. The larvae can enter through bare skin, and the adult worms may cause abdominal symptoms, blood loss, anemia, or poor growth.

Hookworm Infection

Intestinal infection caused by hookworms acquired when larvae in contaminated soil penetrate the skin or are ingested. Chronic infection can cause abdominal symptoms, iron-deficiency anemia, protein loss, and impaired growth in children.

Hookworm Infestation

Intestinal infection by hookworm nematodes, which attach to the intestinal wall and may cause iron-deficiency anemia, abdominal symptoms, or poor growth.

Hordeolum

Alternate medical name; see *Stye*.

Horizontal Gene Transfer

The movement of genetic material between microorganisms rather than from parent to offspring. It can spread traits such as antibiotic resistance through direct contact, viruses, or uptake of DNA from the surroundings.

Horizontal Pursuit

Smooth, coordinated movement of both eyes horizontally to follow a slowly moving visual target while maintaining fixation.

Hormonal Drugs

Medicines that contain, replace, imitate, block, or change the effects of hormones. Examples include insulin, thyroid hormones, corticosteroids, sex hormones, contraceptives, and medicines that block hormones in some cancers. Their uses and risks vary widely by medicine and condition.

Hormonal Effects In Newborns

Transient newborn findings caused by maternal hormones or normal neonatal endocrine transitions, such as breast enlargement or vaginal bleeding; persistent or severe findings require evaluation.

Hormone

A specialized chemical signaling messenger synthesized and secreted in microscopic quantities by endocrine glands (or specialized neuroendocrine cells) directly into the systemic circulation or extracellular fluid, designed to coordinate and modulate the physiological activities, metabolism, growth, development, and homeostasis of distant target cells and organ systems. Functioning via endocrine (bloodstream delivery to distant organs), paracrine (diffusion to adjacent cells), or autocrine (binding to receptors on the secreting cell itself) mechanisms, hormones act with high receptor specificity and exquisite potency at nanomolar to picomolar concentrations. Structurally categorized into three major biochemical classes: (1) Peptide and Protein Hormones (e.g., insulin, glucagon, growth hor-

mone, ACTH, parathyroid hormone, TSH), which are water-soluble, circulate freely, and bind to cell-surface transmembrane receptors (G protein-coupled receptors or receptor tyrosine kinases) to activate second-messenger cascades (cAMP, IP3/DAG, MAPK); (2) Steroid Hormones (e.g., cortisol, aldosterone, estrogen, progesterone, testosterone), derived from cholesterol, which are lipophilic, circulate bound to plasma carrier globulins (CBG, SHBG, albumin), freely diffuse across cell lipid bilayers, and bind intracellular cytoplasmic or nuclear receptors to alter gene transcription; and (3) Amino Acid-Derived (Amine) Hormones (e.g., catecholamines [epinephrine, norepinephrine] derived from tyrosine, and thyroid hormones [T_3, T_4], which uniquely cross membranes via monocarboxylate transporters to bind nuclear thyroid hormone receptors). Hormonal secretion is tightly regulated by negative and positive feedback homeostatic loops governed predominantly by the hypothalamic-pituitary-end organ axes.

Alternate Names:
Hormones; Endocrine Chemical Messenger

Hormone Levels

Measurements of hormones in blood, urine, or other specimens used to evaluate endocrine function; interpretation depends on the specific hormone, timing, age, sex, medications, and clinical context.

Hormone Panel

A coordinated group of blood tests that measures multiple endocrine hormone concentrations to evaluate pituitary, thyroid, adrenal, or reproductive organ function; see *Hormone Levels*.

Hormone Receptor

A protein that binds a specific hormone and converts the signal into cellular responses, either at the cell surface or inside the cell nucleus.

Hormone-Receptor Positive

A cancer whose cells express receptors for hormones such as estrogen or progesterone. Hormone-blocking treatment may be useful for selected cancers with these receptors.

Hormone Replacement Therapy

Treatment that supplies a hormone the body does not make enough of, such as thyroid, adrenal, sex, or pituitary hormones. Menopausal hormone therapy can relieve hot flushes and vaginal symptoms for selected people, but benefits and risks depend on the hormone, dose, duration, and health history.

Hormones

Plural form; see *Hormone*.

Hormone-Sensitive Lipase

An enzyme in fat cells that breaks stored triglycerides into fatty acids and glycerol. Its activity rises when the body needs fuel, including during fasting or exercise, and falls after insulin increases.

Hormone Therapy

Treatment that adds, lowers, blocks, or changes the action of hormones. It may be used for hormone disorders, contraception, or hormone-sensitive cancers; the type and effects depend on the condition and medicine.

Hormone Therapy For Breast Cancer

Treatment that blocks or lowers estrogen or progesterone effects in hormone-sensitive breast cancer. It reduces stimulation of cancer cells and may be used after surgery or for advanced disease.

Hormone Therapy for Endometriosis

Hormonal treatment used to suppress ovarian cycling and reduce endometriosis-related pain or lesion activity. Options include combined hormonal contraceptives, progestins, or other ovarian-suppressing medicines selected according to symptoms, pregnancy plans, and risks.

Hormone Therapy For Prostate Cancer

Treatment that lowers androgen production or blocks androgen action to slow growth of hormone-sensitive prostate cancer.

Horn

A horn is a pointed, hard growth of keratinized

tissue, usually on the skin or as a normal anatomical projection such as a uterine or spinal horn.

Horner's Syndrome

A group of findings caused by disruption of sympathetic nerves, including a drooping eyelid, a small pupil, and reduced sweating on one side of the face.

Horner Syndrome

A neurological condition resulting from a disruption or injury along the nerve pathway (sympathetic chain) that connects the brainstem to the eye and face on one side. The damage produces a classic triad of symptoms on the affected side of the face: a slightly drooping upper eyelid (ptosis), a constricted (smaller) pupil (miosis), and reduced or absent sweating on that side of the face (anhidrosis). Causes include neck injuries, strokes, spinal cord lesions, or tumors in the upper chest or neck.

Alternate Names:
Horner's Syndrome; Oculosympathetic Paresis

Hornet Stings

Hornet stings inject venom and usually cause local pain and swelling; multiple stings or allergy can cause a serious systemic reaction.

Horripilation

Piloerection, or the temporary raising of hair and development of gooseflesh due to cold, fear, emotion, or autonomic stimulation.

Horseshoe Kidney

A birth difference in which the lower parts of the two kidneys join across the middle of the body. Many people have no symptoms, but kidney stones, urine-flow problems, infections, or high blood pressure can occur.

Hospice

Care for a person nearing the end of life when the focus is comfort rather than cure. Hospice supports symptoms, emotional and practical needs, and family caregivers at home, in a hospice facility, or in a hospital; eligibility rules vary by location.

Hospice and Palliative Medicine

The medical specialty focused on relieving symptoms and other burdens of serious illness and supporting quality of life. Palliative care can accompany disease-directed treatment at any stage; hospice is a form of palliative care for people nearing the end of life.

Hospice Care

Team-based care for a person nearing the end of life that prioritizes comfort, symptom control, communication, and family support rather than disease-directed cure.

Hospice Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided during hospice care to maximize comfort, dignity, and participation rather than to restore function at all costs. It may include positioning, pain relief, safe transfers, equipment, and caregiver education.

Hospital-Acquired Infection

A localized or systemic infectious condition developing in a hospitalized patient that was neither present nor incubating at the time of hospital admission, medically defined as manifesting at least 48 hours following admission, or within 30 days after surgical discharge (up to 90 days following surgical implant placement). Driven by the convergence of vulnerable, immunocompromised hosts, invasive diagnostic and therapeutic devices that breach mucosal/cutaneous defense barriers, and high ambient concentrations of multidrug-resistant (MDR) pathogens within clinical environments. The four predominant clinical device- and procedure-related categories comprise: (1) Catheter-Associated Urinary Tract Infections (CAUTI, the most frequent, commonly due to *Escherichia coli*, *Klebsiella*, or *Candida*); (2) Central Line-Associated Bloodstream Infections (CLABSI, caused by biofilm-forming pathogens including coagulase-negative staphylococci, *Staphylococcus aureus*, and enterococci); (3) Ventilator-Associated Pneumonia (VAP, developing $>$ 48 hours following endotracheal intubation, frequently caused by virulent gram-negative bacilli such as *Pseudomonas aeruginosa*, *Acinetobacter bau-*

mannii, and MRSA); and (4) Surgical Site Infections (SSI, classified as superficial incisional, deep incisional, or organ/space). Also encompasses healthcare facility-acquired *Clostridioides difficile* colitis induced by broad-spectrum antimicrobial selective pressure. Prevention mandates strict adherence to evidence-based infection control bundles, rigorous hand hygiene, antimicrobial stewardship, sterile insertion techniques, and early removal of unnecessary indwelling catheters and invasive devices.

Alternate Names:
Hospital-Acquired Infections; Nosocomial Infection; Healthcare-Associated Infection; HAI

Hospital-Acquired Infections

Plural form; see *Hospital-Acquired Infection*.

Hospital-Acquired Pneumonia

Lung infection that begins at least 48 hours after hospital admission and was not present when the person arrived. It may cause fever, cough, breathing difficulty, or low oxygen; treatment depends on severity, cultures, and resistance risk.

Hospital- and Ventilator-Associated Pneumonia

Pneumonia developing during hospitalization, including ventilator-associated pneumonia after mechanical ventilation. Diagnosis considers new infiltrates or respiratory decline plus clinical evidence of infection; antimicrobial selection depends on local resistance, prior antibiotics, and patient risk factors.

Hospital-Associated Disability

New or worsened difficulty with walking, self-care, or other daily activities that develops during or after hospitalization. It may result from illness, bed rest, weakness, delirium, poor nutrition, or treatments and can persist after discharge.

Hospital Code

An announcement used in a hospital to summon staff for an emergency. The number or color and the required response depend on that hospital's policy.

Hospital Latex Allergy Precautions

Clinical protocols and institutional safety measures implemented to protect sensitized hospital patients and healthcare workers from natural rubber latex exposure. Includes using non-latex gloves, latex-free medical devices, and clear allergy identification band protocols.

Alternate Names:
Latex Allergy Protocol; Latex-Safe Environment; Natural Rubber Latex Precautions

Host

A person or other living organism that can be infected by a virus or other pathogen under natural conditions. The host may be a human, animal, or plant. In medical contexts, the host is the patient in whom an infection or disease develops.

Host Cell

A cell in which an infectious agent, parasite, or symbiont lives, replicates, or uses cellular machinery; the host-cell response influences disease and clearance.

Hostility

An attitude or behavior marked by antagonism, anger, distrust, or intent to oppose another person; persistent severe hostility may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, substance-related, or situational problems.

Host Response

The body's reaction to an infection, foreign material, transplanted tissue, or other stimulus. It may include inflammation, immune defense, healing, scar formation, rejection, or tolerance.

Hot Flash

Alternate singular form; see *Hot Flashes*.

Hot Flashes

Sudden episodes of intense heat, sweating, flushing, and sometimes a racing heart or chills. They are common during menopause but can also result from hormone changes, medicines, cancer treatment, or

other illness.

Hot Flushes

Alternate name; see *Hot Flashes*.

Hot Tub Folliculitis

A temporary bacterial infection of hair follicles, commonly caused by Pseudomonas aeruginosa after exposure to contaminated hot tubs or pools, producing itchy follicular papules or pustules.

Hounsfield Unit

A standard scale of measurement used in computed tomography (CT) scans to describe the density of different tissues in the body. Named after Sir Godfrey Hounsfield, one of the inventors of the CT scan, the scale assigns pure water a value of zero, air a value of negative 1000, and dense bone high positive values, allowing radiologists to distinguish fluid, fat, soft tissue, and bone on scans.

Alternate Names:
Hounsfield Units; HU; CT Number

Hounsfield Units

Plural form; see *Hounsfield Unit*.

Hour

A unit of time equal to 60 minutes, commonly used in medicine to describe symptom duration, dosing intervals, monitoring periods, and treatment timing.

Hour-Glass Contraction

An abnormal tight band that divides the uterus into upper and lower sections during difficult labor. It can obstruct delivery and is an obstetric emergency.

Housemaid's Knee

A common name for prepatellar bursitis, inflammation and fluid accumulation in the bursa over the kneecap, often caused by prolonged kneeling, trauma, infection, or inflammatory disease. Painful swelling, redness, warmth, or fever requires assessment for septic bursitis.

Howell-Jolly Bodies

Small leftover pieces of red-cell DNA seen on a blood smear. They are usually removed by a working spleen, so their presence may indicate absent or reduced spleen function; they can also occur with severe vitamin-B12 or folate deficiency.

Howship-Romberg Sign

Pain and paresthesias radiating along the medial and inner aspect of the thigh to the knee, caused by compression of the obturator nerve within the obturator canal by an obturator hernia, exacerbated by extension, abduction, and internal rotation of the hip.

Alternate Names:
Howship-Romberg Symptom; Obturator Nerve Compression Sign

HPA (Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis)

A hormone system linking parts of the brain with the adrenal glands. It helps the body respond to stress by controlling the release of cortisol, which affects blood pressure, blood sugar, immune activity, sleep, and energy.

Alternate Names:
Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis

HPLC

A laboratory method that separates substances in a liquid sample so they can be identified and measured. It is used to test medicines, body chemicals, poisons, and other samples.

HPV/Genital Warts

Alternate name; see *Human Papillomavirus* and *Genital Warts*.

HPV (Human Papillomavirus)

Alternate name; see *Human Papillomavirus*.

HPV Infection

Alternate name; see *Human Papillomavirus Infection*.

HPV Test

A test that detects high-risk human papillomavirus genetic material or related markers in cervical samples to screen for cervical cancer risk or evaluate abnormal cervical cytology.

H. Pylori

Abbreviated name; see *Helicobacter Pylori*.

HPylori

Abbreviated name; see *Helicobacter Pylori*.

H. Pylori Stool Antigen

A stool test that detects proteins from *Helicobacter pylori*, a stomach bacterium. It can help diagnose an active infection and check whether treatment has cleared it. Medicines that reduce stomach acid and recent antibiotics can affect the result, so timing matters.

Alternate Names:
HpSA; Stool Antigen Test for H. Pylori

H. pylori Test

A diagnostic test (urea breath test, stool antigen assay, or biopsy) detecting *Helicobacter pylori* infection in the gastric mucosa; see *Helicobacter Pylori* and *Urea Breath Test*.

HRCT (High-Resolution Computed Tomography)

Alternate name; see *High-Resolution Computed Tomography*.

H-Reflex

An electrical response recorded during nerve-conduction testing after stimulation of a nerve, commonly the tibial nerve. It assesses the reflex pathway between sensory and motor nerves in the spinal cord and is used especially to evaluate the S1 nerve root.

Alternate Names:
Electrophysiological Monosynaptic Reflex

HRT (Hormone Replacement Therapy)

Hormone replacement therapy uses estrogen, with a progestogen when needed, to treat selected menopausal symptoms caused by declining ovarian hormone production. It can relieve vasomotor and genitourinary symptoms and help prevent bone loss, but benefits and risks depend on the person's age, medical history, regimen, and duration of use.

Hs-cTn

Alternate name; see *High-Sensitivity Cardiac Troponin*.

Ht (Hematocrit)

Common abbreviation for hematocrit, the percentage of blood volume occupied by red blood cells; in other contexts it may mean height.

Huber Needle

A special non-coring needle used to access an implanted port for giving medicines, fluids, blood products, or taking blood samples. Correct placement and sterile technique reduce infection, bleeding, and port damage.

Hughes-Stovin Syndrome

An extremely rare condition involving blood clots in deep veins and several aneurysms in the lung arteries. It may be related to Behçet disease and can cause life-threatening bleeding in the lungs.

Alternate Names:
HSS; Pulmonary Artery Aneurysm-Thrombosis Syndrome

Human African Trypanosomiasis

A parasitic disease caused by *Trypanosoma brucei* and spread by infected tsetse flies in sub-Saharan Africa. It first affects the blood and lymph and can later involve the brain and spinal cord, causing sleep-wake changes, confusion, or other nervous-system problems. The two forms, caused by *T. b. gambiense* and *T. b. rhodesiense*, usually progress at different rates. Untreated disease can be fatal.

Alternate Names:
African Sleeping Sickness; African Trypanosomiasis; Sleeping Sickness

Human Bites

Injuries caused by human teeth that can inoculate mixed oral bacteria into skin, joints, tendons, or bone. Bites to the hand, deep punctures, delayed presentation, or signs of infection carry increased risk of complications; management can include wound care, antibiotics, and tetanus prevention.

Human Calcitonin

A peptide hormone produced by thyroid parafollicular cells that can lower blood calcium by inhibiting osteoclast activity; synthetic calcitonin is used selectively for bone and calcium disorders.

Human Chorionic Gonadotropin

A hormone produced mainly by the placenta and measured in blood or urine to detect and monitor pregnancy. Levels normally rise early in pregnancy; results vary with timing and other clinical findings.

Alternate Names:
HCG

Human Chorionic Gonadotropin Test

A qualitative or quantitative blood or urine test measuring hCG, a hormone produced by the placenta during pregnancy or by certain germ-cell tumors; see *Human Chorionic Gonadotropin* and *Pregnancy Test*.

Human Chromosome Count

Most human body cells contain 46 chromosomes arranged in 23 pairs, including one pair of sex chromosomes; mature egg and sperm cells normally contain 23.

Human Cyclic Neutropenia

Alternate name; see *Cyclic Neutropenia*.

Human Cytomegalovirus Infection

Alternate name; see *Cytomegalovirus Infection*.

Human Embryo

The developing human organism from fertilization through approximately the eighth week, during which the major body plan and organ systems are established.

Human Gastrin

A peptide hormone produced mainly by gastric G cells that stimulates gastric acid secretion and supports growth of the gastric mucosa after food enters the stomach.

Human Genome

The complete DNA sequence and genetic content of a human, organized into nuclear chromosomes and mitochondrial DNA; variants influence traits, disease risk, and treatment response.

Human Herpesvirus 6

A herpesvirus that commonly infects children and can cause roseola; it may reactivate and cause serious disease in people with weakened immunity.

Human Herpesvirus 8

A herpesvirus associated with Kaposi sarcoma, primary effusion lymphoma, and multicentric Castleman disease, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Human Immunodeficiency Virus

A virus that attacks immune cells, especially CD4 cells, and can gradually weaken the body's defenses. Without effective treatment it may lead to AIDS and serious infections or cancers. HIV-1 is widespread globally and HIV-2 is less common; daily treatment can suppress the virus and protect health.

Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV)

Alternate name; see *Human Immunodeficiency Virus*.

Human Leukocyte Antigen

A group of cell-surface proteins encoded by genes in the major histocompatibility complex. HLA molecules present antigens to T cells and are important in immune responses and tissue matching for transplantation.

Alternate Names:

HLA Complex; Human MHC

Human Metapneumovirus

A respiratory virus that commonly causes cough, fever, runny nose, and wheezing. Infants, older adults, and people with weakened immunity may develop bronchiolitis, pneumonia, or severe breathing difficulty.

Human Microbiome

The community of bacteria, viruses, fungi, archaea, and other microorganisms living on and inside the human body. These organisms and their genes can influence digestion, immune activity, metabolism, and disease, although finding a microorganism does not by itself prove that it causes illness.

Human Nociceptin

A neuropeptide that binds the nociceptin/orphanin FQ receptor and modulates pain, stress, reward, autonomic function, and other brain and spinal-cord processes.

Human Papillomavirus

A large group of viruses that infect the skin and moist body linings. Some types cause warts; persistent infection with high-risk types can lead to precancerous changes and cancers. See also *Human Papillomavirus Infection*.

Alternate Names:
HPV

Human Papillomavirus (HPV/Genital Warts)

Alternate name; see *Human Papillomavirus*.

Human Papillomavirus Infection

Infection with one or more human papillomavirus (HPV) types, spread mainly through intimate skin-to-skin or sexual contact. Most infections cause no symptoms and clear without causing health problems. Some types cause warts; persistent infection with high-risk types can cause precancerous changes and cancers of the cervix, anus, genitals, or throat. Vaccination prevents many infections, and cervical screening can detect precancerous changes.

Human Papillomavirus Vaccine

A vaccine that prevents infection from selected human papillomavirus (HPV) types and reduces the risk of HPV-related cancers; some formulations also prevent most genital warts caused by HPV. It does not treat an existing HPV infection.

Human Placental Lactogen

A hormone made by the placenta during pregnancy. It helps prepare the breasts for feeding and changes how the pregnant person uses fat and sugar, helping provide nutrients to the developing fetus.

Human T-Lymphotropic Virus Type 1 Infection

Infection with human T-lymphotropic virus type 1 (HTLV-1), a retrovirus transmitted mainly through breastfeeding, sexual contact, or contaminated blood. Most infected people remain asymptomatic, but a minority develop adult T-cell leukemia-lymphoma or HTLV-1-associated myelopathy/tropical spastic paraparesis.

Alternate Names:
HTLV-1 Infection; Human T-Cell Lymphotropic Virus Type 1 Infection

Humectant

A substance that attracts and holds water, often used in skin creams, lotions, foods, and medicines. In skincare, it draws water into the outer skin layer and can reduce dryness when used properly.

Humeral Epicondyle

A bony prominence at the distal humerus that provides attachment for forearm muscles and ligaments; the medial and lateral epicondyles are located on opposite sides of the elbow.

Humeral Fracture

A break in the upper-arm bone, involving the proximal, shaft, or distal humerus; pain, swelling, deformity, and possible nerve or blood-vessel injury guide urgent assessment and treatment.

Humeroradial Joint

The part of the elbow where the upper-arm bone meets the radius, one of the forearm bones. It helps the elbow bend and straighten and supports rotation of the forearm.

Humeroulnar Joint

The main hinge of the elbow, where the upper-arm bone meets the ulna. It allows the arm to bend and straighten and provides much of the elbow's stability.

Humerus

The long bone of the upper arm, extending from the shoulder to the elbow. It joins the shoulder blade above and the radius and ulna below; fractures can injure nearby nerves or blood vessels.

Humerus Fracture

A break in the upper-arm bone caused by trauma, falls, overuse, or weakened bone. Pain, swelling, deformity, and impaired movement may occur, with assessment for nerve and vascular injury.

Humidifier

A device that adds moisture to air; medical humidifiers require appropriate cleaning and water handling because contaminated equipment can disperse infectious or inflammatory material.

Humidifier Fever

A flu-like illness caused by inhalation of microorganisms or biologic contaminants from a contaminated humidifier or ventilation system, often involving fever, chills, cough, and malaise.

Humidity

The amount of water vapor in air, influencing heat loss, respiratory comfort, skin hydration, and survival or transmission of some microorganisms.

Humor

In anatomy, a fluid of the body, especially the aqueous or vitreous humor of the eye; in ordinary language, it means a sense of amusement or comedy.

Humoral Immunity

The part of the immune system that protects mainly through antibodies made by B cells. Antibodies can block germs and toxins and help other immune cells remove them.

Hunchback

A nontechnical term usually referring to pronounced kyphosis, an excessive forward curvature of the upper spine. Causes include osteoporosis, vertebral compression fractures, Scheuermann disease, degenerative change, and congenital disorders; evaluation depends on age, progression, pain, and neurologic findings.

Hunger

The physical drive to eat, influenced by stomach fullness, blood glucose, hormones such as ghrelin, emotions, habits, illness, and the availability or appeal of food.

Hungry Bone Syndrome

A severe drop in blood calcium after treatment of overactive parathyroid glands, often after surgery. Healing bones rapidly take up calcium and other minerals, causing tingling, cramps, spasms, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Hunter's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Hunter Syndrome*.

Hunter Syndrome

An inherited condition, usually affecting boys, in which iduronate-2-sulfatase deficiency causes complex sugars to accumulate in tissues. It can cause coarse facial features, enlarged organs, stiff joints, hearing loss, breathing problems, and developmental difficulties.

Huntington Disease

A progressive, inherited neurodegenerative disorder caused by a faulty gene that produces a toxic form of the huntingtin protein, leading to the gradual breakdown of nerve cells in the brain. Symptoms usually emerge in adulthood (between ages 30 and 50) and include involuntary jerking or writhing movements

(chorea), poor coordination, mood swings, personality changes, and progressive cognitive decline.

Alternate Names:
Huntington's Disease; Huntington Chorea

Huntington's Chorea (HD)

Alternate name; see *Huntington Disease*.

Huntington's Disease (HD)

Alternate name; see *Huntington Disease*.

Hurler Disease

Alternate name for severe mucopolysaccharidosis type I; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I*.

Hurler Syndrome

Mucopolysaccharidosis type I (MPS I), the severe form, an autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by alpha-L-iduronidase deficiency (IDUA gene mutations). Accumulation of dermatan sulfate and heparan sulfate leads to progressive multisystem involvement.

Hurthle Cell

A thyroid follicular cell with abundant granular mitochondria-rich cytoplasm, seen in Hashimoto thyroiditis and Hürthle-cell neoplasms.

Hurthle Cell Cancer

A rare thyroid cancer arising from Hurthle cells, with behavior ranging from indolent to aggressive.

Alternate Names:
Oxyphilic Thyroid Carcinoma; Oncocytoid Carcinoma

Hurthle Cell Carcinoma (Oncocytic Carcinoma)

A differentiated thyroid cancer composed predominantly of oncocytic, or Hurthle, cells. It may behave more aggressively than some other differentiated thyroid cancers and is evaluated with thyroid imaging, cytology or histology, staging, and molecular findings.

Hürthle Cell Tumour

A growth arising from hormone-making cells in the thyroid. It may be benign or cancerous; ultrasound and examination of thyroid tissue help determine its nature and treatment.

Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome

An extremely rare, fatal autosomal dominant progeroid disorder caused by a de novo point mutation in the *LMNA* gene that produces an aberrant, farnesylated lamin A protein called progerin, resulting in accelerated nuclear instability, premature aging, alopecia, atherosclerosis, and death from stroke or myocardial infarction in adolescence.

Alternate Names:
Progeria; HGPS

Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome (HGPS)

Alternate name; see *Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome*.

Hutchinson-Gilford Syndrome (HGPS)

Alternate name; see *Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome*.

Hutchinson Sign

In herpes zoster ophthalmicus, vesicles on the tip, side, or root of the nose indicate involvement of the nasociliary branch of the ophthalmic division of the trigeminal nerve (cranial nerve V1). This sign is associated with increased risk of eye complications, but eye involvement can occur without nasal lesions.

Alternate Names:
Hutchinson's Sign; Nasociliary Zoster Sign

Hutchinson's Teeth

Hutchinson's teeth are permanently notched, widely spaced upper front teeth classically associated with congenital syphilis.

Hutchinson Teeth

A classic dental developmental abnormality occurring in congenital syphilis, characterized by permanent upper central incisors that are small, peg-

shaped, or screwdriver-shaped with a distinctive central semilunar notch on their biting edge.

Alternate Names:
Hutchinson's Teeth; Notched Syphilitic Incisors

Hutchinson Triad

The classic diagnostic clinical triad of late congenital syphilis, consisting of chronic interstitial keratitis, eighth cranial nerve sensorineural deafness, and Hutchinson notched central incisors.

Alternate Names:
Hutchinson's Triad; Congenital Syphilis Triad

Hyaline

A glassy, translucent material or appearance, commonly describing proteinaceous deposits or homogeneous extracellular material seen microscopically in tissues.

Hyaline Cartilage

The most common type of cartilage, containing fine type II collagen fibers in a firm, glassy matrix. It supports airways, covers articular surfaces, and forms much of the fetal skeleton and growth plates.

Hyaline Casts

Clear, tube-shaped particles sometimes seen in urine. A small number may be normal, especially after exercise or dehydration; larger numbers can occur when the kidneys are under stress, with significance depending on other urine and blood findings.

Hyaline Membrane

A protein-rich layer that forms along the walls of damaged air sacs in the lungs. It blocks oxygen transfer and is classically seen in newborn respiratory distress caused by inadequate surfactant.

Hyalitis

Inflammation of the vitreous body of the eye, usually associated with intraocular infection, autoimmune inflammation, trauma, or another ocular disorder. It may cause floaters, blurred vision, or visual loss and requires ophthalmic assessment.

Hyaloid Canal

A narrow channel through the vitreous body of the eye that marks the former path of the hyaloid artery from the optic disc toward the lens during fetal development.

Hyaluronic Acid

A naturally occurring carbohydrate polymer that binds water in connective tissue, skin, joints, and the eye.

Alternate Names:
Hyaluronan; Sodium Hyaluronate

Hyaluronidase

An enzyme that breaks down hyaluronic acid in connective tissue. Medicines containing it can help injected fluids or medicines spread through tissue and may also dissolve certain hyaluronic-acid cosmetic fillers.

Hyaluronoglucosaminidase

An enzyme that degrades hyaluronan and related glycosaminoglycans; hyaluronidase preparations can increase tissue permeability and assist dispersion of injected fluids or medicines.

Hybridoma

A cell line formed by fusing an antibody-producing B lymphocyte with an immortal myeloma cell, allowing continuous production of a monoclonal antibody.

Hycanthone

An older antiparasitic drug formerly used against schistosomiasis; its use was abandoned or restricted because of serious toxicity, including liver injury and carcinogenic concern.

Hydatid Cyst

A cyst caused by the larval stage of Echinococcus granulosus, a tapeworm transmitted from dogs to humans through ingestion of contaminated food. The liver is the most commonly affected organ, followed by the lungs. Cysts grow slowly and may become symptomatic from mass effect or rupture, causing anaphylaxis.

Hydatid Disease

A parasitic infection caused by *Echinococcus* tapeworms. People usually become infected by swallowing eggs from infected dogs or contaminated food, water, or soil. Slow-growing fluid-filled cysts can form, most often in the liver or lungs. A leaking or burst cyst can cause a severe allergic reaction and spread the infection; treatment depends on the cyst and may include medicine, a procedure, or surgery.

Alternate Names:
Echinococcosis; Cystic echinococcosis; Hydatidosis

Hydatidiform Mole

A form of gestational trophoblastic disease in which abnormal trophoblastic tissue grows in the uterus. A complete mole has no viable fetus; a partial mole may contain abnormal fetal tissue. Both require follow-up because persistent disease can occur.

Hydralazine

Hydralazine is a direct arteriolar vasodilator used for selected hypertension, including severe hypertension in pregnancy; reflex tachycardia, fluid retention, headache, and drug-induced lupus are recognized adverse effects.

Hydramnios

Excess amniotic fluid during pregnancy, also called polyhydramnios, caused by fetal swallowing impairment, maternal diabetes, multiple gestation, fetal anomalies, infection, or sometimes no identifiable cause.

Hydranencephaly

A rare brain development disorder in which most of the upper brain is replaced by fluid-filled spaces. It can cause severe developmental and movement problems, seizures, feeding difficulty, and a shortened life expectancy.

Hydrarthrosis

Abnormal accumulation of clear synovial fluid within a joint, producing swelling and restricted movement; causes include osteoarthritis, inflammatory arthritis, trauma, and infection.

Hydration

The body's water balance and the process of replacing water and electrolytes lost through urine, stool, sweat, breathing, vomiting, or bleeding.

Hydrazine

A colorless, volatile, and flammable chemical compound with an ammonia-like odor. While widely recognized in industry and aerospace as a high-energy rocket fuel, hydrazine derivatives have played significant roles in medicine as chemical building blocks for certain antibiotics (such as the tuberculosis drug isoniazid) and antidepressant medications.

Alternate Names:
Hydrazines; Diamine

Hydrazines

Plural form; see *Hydrazine*.

Hydrazine Sulfate

A hydrazine-containing chemical once promoted experimentally for cancer-related symptoms; evidence of benefit is inadequate and toxicity can include liver injury, neuropathy, and seizures.

Hydrazones

Chemical compounds formed by reaction of hydrazine derivatives with aldehydes or ketones, important in medicinal chemistry, analytical chemistry, and some drug structures.

Hydroa Vacciniforme

A rare photodermatosis causing recurrent vesicles or papules on sun-exposed skin that heal with varioliform scars; some cases are associated with Epstein-Barr virus.

Hydrocarbon

An organic compound composed only of carbon and hydrogen; ingestion or inhalation of petroleum hydrocarbons can cause chemical pneumonitis and systemic toxicity.

Hydrocarbon Pneumonia

Lung inflammation caused by inhaling or aspirating

petroleum products or other hydrocarbons, which can produce cough, breathing difficulty, and chemical pneumonitis.

Hydrocarbon Toxicity

Poisoning from petroleum distillates or other hydrocarbons, with the greatest danger often being aspiration and chemical pneumonitis after ingestion. Cough, choking, hypoxia, respiratory failure, central nervous system depression, or dysrhythmias may occur; treatment is mainly respiratory and supportive because vomiting or routine gastric lavage can worsen aspiration.

Hydrocele

A collection of fluid around a testicle. It may be present from birth or develop after infection, injury, or another problem. It often causes painless swelling; examination and, when needed, ultrasound help confirm the cause.

Hydrocele Repair

Surgery to close or remove the fluid-containing sac around a testicle when a hydrocele is persistent, large, painful, associated with a hernia, or obscures examination.

Hydrocephalus

A buildup of fluid in spaces inside the brain called ventricles. These spaces can enlarge and sometimes raise pressure inside the skull. It may be present at birth or develop later, often because fluid cannot flow or drain normally. Signs vary with age and can include a rapidly growing head in babies or walking, vision, memory, or bladder problems in adults.

Hydrocephalus Acquired

Acquired hydrocephalus is abnormal accumulation of cerebrospinal fluid after birth due to obstruction, impaired absorption, or rarely excess production; raised intracranial pressure may cause headache, vomiting, gait or cognitive change, and visual symptoms.

Hydrocephalus Ex-Vacuo

Enlargement of the brain's ventricles secondary to loss or shrinkage of surrounding brain tissue, rather than primarily from obstructed cerebrospinal-fluid flow.

Hydrocephaly

Hydrocephalus: abnormal accumulation or circulation of cerebrospinal fluid that enlarges the ventricles and may increase pressure on the brain.

Hydrochloric Acid

The strong acid in stomach juice that helps digest proteins and kill many swallowed microorganisms. The stomach's mucus lining and other protective mechanisms normally prevent this acid from damaging its tissues.

Hydrochloric Acid Poisoning

A corrosive injury after swallowing, inhaling, or contacting hydrochloric acid. It can burn the mouth, throat, esophagus, stomach, skin, or lungs and may cause airway swelling, bleeding, or perforation.

Hydrochlorothiazide

Hydrochlorothiazide is a thiazide diuretic that inhibits sodium-chloride reabsorption in the distal convoluted tubule and treats hypertension and mild oedema; hypokalaemia, hyponatraemia, hyperuricaemia, and photosensitivity may occur.

Hydrocodone

An opioid analgesic used for moderate to severe pain and, in some formulations, cough; it can cause respiratory depression, sedation, constipation, tolerance, dependence, and overdose.

Hydrocodone And Acetaminophen Overdose

Taking too much of this opioid-and-pain-reliever combination can slow breathing and cause coma, while acetaminophen can severely damage the liver. Emergency treatment is needed even before symptoms appear.

Hydrocodone Bitartrate

The bitartrate salt of hydrocodone, an opioid anal-

gesic that can cause sedation, constipation, respiratory depression, tolerance, dependence, and overdose.

Hydrocodone/Oxycodone Overdose

Taking too much hydrocodone or oxycodone can cause extreme sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or stopped breathing, coma, and death. Treatment may include naloxone, assisted ventilation, and close monitoring.

Hydrocolpos

Distension of the vagina with fluid due to obstruction of the vaginal outlet, often from an imperforate hymen or transverse septum, presenting as a pelvic mass in neonates or adolescents.

Hydrocortisone

A corticosteroid identical or similar to the body's cortisol. It reduces inflammation and immune activity and treats adrenal hormone deficiency; prolonged or high-dose use can cause infection, high blood sugar, skin thinning, or adrenal suppression.

Hydrocyanic Acid Poisoning

A life-threatening poisoning that prevents cells from using oxygen. It can cause sudden headache, confusion, seizures, breathing failure, cardiovascular collapse, and death; emergency antidote treatment is required immediately.

Hydroflumethiazide

An older thiazide diuretic that increases urinary salt and water loss to lower blood pressure or reduce swelling. It can disturb sodium, potassium, and glucose levels and may cause dehydration or increased uric acid.

Hydrofluoric Acid Exposure

Contact with hydrofluoric acid, which can cause deep tissue injury and systemic fluoride toxicity, including dangerous low calcium and cardiac arrhythmias.

Hydrofluoric Acid Poisoning

A medical emergency after contact with or inhalation of hydrofluoric acid. It can cause deep tissue burns and dangerous low calcium, heart rhythm changes, or death, even when the skin injury looks minor.

Hydrogel

A water-rich three-dimensional material that can hold and release substances. Hydrogels are used in wound dressings, contact lenses, drug delivery, tissue engineering, and research, with safety depending on composition and use.

Hydrogenation

A chemical process that adds hydrogen to a compound; in foods it can convert liquid oils into more solid fats.

Hydrogen Bond

A weak attraction between a hydrogen atom attached to an electronegative atom and another electronegative atom. These bonds help maintain the shapes of proteins and DNA and influence water's properties.

Hydrogen Breath Test

A test for some causes of bloating, diarrhea, or abdominal pain. After drinking a measured sugar solution, the person breathes into collection tubes at intervals. The gases can suggest poor sugar absorption or excess bacteria in the small intestine.

Hydrogen Cyanide

A rapidly acting cellular toxin that inhibits cytochrome oxidase and prevents oxidative phosphorylation; significant exposure can cause severe lactic acidosis, seizures, cardiovascular collapse, and death.

Hydrogen-Ion Concentration

The concentration of hydrogen ions in a solution, expressed through pH and central to acid–base physiology, enzyme activity, and interpretation of blood-gas results.

Hydrogen Peroxide

An oxidizing chemical used in some antiseptic and industrial products; ingestion or concentrated exposure can injure tissue and release gas, causing embolic or respiratory complications.

Hydrogen Peroxide Poisoning

Harm after swallowing or inhaling hydrogen peroxide. It may irritate or burn tissues and release gas that blocks blood vessels; concentrated products can cause severe injury, so urgent poison-control or emergency advice is required.

Hydrogen Sulfide

A toxic, flammable gas with a rotten-egg odor at low concentrations that inhibits cellular respiration and can rapidly cause respiratory failure, neurologic effects, or death.

Hydromorphone

Hydromorphone is a potent opioid analgesic for severe pain; sedation, constipation, respiratory depression, tolerance, and dependence are important risks, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Hydromorphone Overdose

Taking too much hydromorphone, an opioid, can cause extreme sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or stopped breathing, coma, and death. Treatment may include naloxone, assisted ventilation, and close monitoring.

Hydromyelia

Abnormal widening of the central canal of the spinal cord, which may be congenital or associated with obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid flow and neurologic symptoms.

Hydronephrosis

Swelling of a kidney because urine cannot drain normally. Causes include a stone, narrowing, reflux, a tumor, or prostate enlargement. Prolonged or severe blockage can damage the kidney and may cause pain, infection, or reduced kidney function.

Hydronephrosis In Newborns

Swelling of a newborn's kidney caused by widened urine-collecting spaces. It may result from temporary changes, blockage, or urine flowing backward and can affect one or both kidneys.

Hydronephrosis Of One Kidney

Dilation of one kidney's renal pelvis and calyces caused by impaired urine drainage, often from a stone, stricture, reflux, or obstruction of the ureter or ureteropelvic junction.

Hydrophobia

An involuntary, agonizing spasm of the throat and vocal cord muscles triggered by attempting to drink or by the sight, sound, or mention of water. It is the hallmark neurological sign of furious (encephalitic) rabies, caused by viral damage to brainstem swallowing centers. The severe choking and pain make swallowing impossible, leading to a terrified avoidance of liquids, excessive drooling (hypersalivation), and often aerophobia (spasms triggered by a draft of air). Once hydrophobia appears, rabies is nearly 100% fatal, highlighting the critical need for immediate post-exposure rabies vaccination following animal bites.

Alternate Names:
Rabic Hydrophobia; Rabid Pharyngeal Spasms; Fear of Water in Rabies

Hydropneumothorax

Air and fluid collected together in the space around a lung. It can compress the lung and cause chest pain or severe breathing difficulty, often requiring urgent hospital treatment and drainage.

Hydrops

Abnormal accumulation of fluid in tissues or body cavities. In fetal medicine, *hydrops fetalis* means abnormal fluid in at least two fetal compartments, such as the skin, abdomen, space around the lungs, or space around the heart. Outside this use, the affected site should be specified.

Hydrops Fetalis

Severe fluid buildup in an unborn baby, affecting

at least two areas such as under the skin, around the lungs, around the heart, or in the abdomen. Causes include blood-group incompatibility, anemia, infection, genetic conditions, heart problems, and complications of twin pregnancy.

Hydrops Of The Gallbladder

Distension of the gallbladder by clear mucus or watery fluid, usually caused by prolonged obstruction of the cystic duct by a gallstone. It may cause right-upper-quadrant pain and can progress to inflammation or infection.

Hydrosalpinx

A fallopian tube swollen with trapped fluid because its end near the ovary is blocked. Scarring from a past pelvic infection is a common cause; endometriosis or pelvic surgery can also block the tube. It may cause no symptoms but can make it harder to become pregnant.

Hydrotherapy

Exercise or treatment performed in water. Water supports body weight and provides gentle resistance, which may reduce pain and help movement, strength, and balance during rehabilitation. Programs vary with a person's condition and safety needs.

Hydrothorax

An abnormal collection of clear fluid in the pleural space around a lung. It may result from heart, liver, kidney, or other disease and can cause breathlessness, cough, or chest pressure.

Hydroureter

Abnormal enlargement of a ureter caused by impaired urine drainage.

Hydroxamic Acid

An organic functional group containing hydroxylamine attached to a carbonyl, found in chelators and some medicines, including histone-deacetylase inhibitors.

Hydroxocobalamin

A cobalt-containing form of vitamin B12 used as an antidote for cyanide poisoning. It binds cyanide to form cyanocobalamin, which is excreted in urine; it can cause red discoloration of skin and body fluids and interfere with some laboratory tests.

Hydroxyapatite

A calcium-and-phosphate mineral that gives much of their hardness to bones and teeth. Bone cells continually remove and replace it as bone grows, repairs itself, and responds to changing physical forces.

Hydroxychloroquine

Hydroxychloroquine is an antimalarial and immunomodulatory drug used for malaria prevention or treatment and selected autoimmune diseases; cumulative retinal toxicity requires ophthalmic monitoring.

Hydroxychloroquine Retinopathy

Retinal damage caused by hydroxychloroquine, usually after prolonged exposure, affecting the parafoveal or pericentral retina around the macula. Early changes may cause no symptoms; progression can produce blind spots or loss of central vision. Damage is often irreversible, and advanced disease may continue to worsen after the drug is stopped. Risk increases with higher daily doses, longer use, kidney disease, tamoxifen use, and older age when treatment begins.

Alternate Names:
Hydroxychloroquine Retinal Toxicity

Hydroxycholesterols

Oxidized forms of cholesterol produced in the body or during food processing. They participate in cell signaling and cholesterol regulation and may contribute to inflammation or blood-vessel disease when present in excess.

Hydroxylase Deficiency (21-Hydroxylase)

An inherited condition in which the adrenal glands cannot make enough of certain hormones. It can cause salt loss, low blood pressure, and excess male-

type hormones, and is the most common cause of congenital adrenal hyperplasia.

Hydroxylation

An enzymatic or chemical reaction that adds a hydroxyl group to a molecule, often altering the activity, solubility, metabolism, or excretion of a drug or biomolecule.

Hydroxyproline

An amino acid formed mainly by post-translational modification of collagen; its measurement has been used as an indicator of collagen turnover but is not a routine diagnostic test.

Hydroxyprolinemia

A rare inherited metabolic finding caused by impaired hydroxyproline breakdown, leading to elevated hydroxyproline in blood or urine and usually little clinical illness.

Hydroxysteroid

A steroid hormone or steroid-related compound containing a hydroxyl group; hydroxysteroids include intermediates and products of adrenal and gonadal steroid metabolism.

Hydroxyurea

A medicine used for some blood cancers and sickle-cell disease. In sickle-cell disease it can reduce painful episodes and other complications by helping red blood cells remain less likely to sickle; blood counts and other safety tests are required.

Hydroxyzine

Hydroxyzine is a sedating H1-antihistamine used for itching, anxiety, and preoperative sedation; drowsiness, anticholinergic effects, and QT prolongation can occur.

Hydroxyzine Overdose

Taking too much hydroxyzine can cause severe drowsiness, confusion, agitation, seizures, low blood pressure, or dangerous heart-rhythm changes. Large or intentional overdoses can be life-threatening.

Hydrozoa

A group of mostly marine animals that includes hydroids and some jellyfish. Contact with certain species can cause painful stings or skin irritation; the medical risk depends on the species and exposure.

Hygiene

Practices that reduce exposure to pathogens and support health, including hand hygiene, oral care, skin care, food safety, and appropriate environmental cleanliness.

Hygiene Hypothesis

The theory that limited early-life microbial exposure may increase susceptibility to allergies and immune disorders.

Hygroma

A fluid-filled swelling, often caused by leakage or blockage of lymphatic vessels. A cystic hygroma usually appears in the neck of a fetus or child, while other hygromas may occur near joints or after injury.

Hygroma Colli

Alternate name for a cystic hygroma, a congenital lymphatic malformation usually involving the neck; see *Cystic Hygroma*.

Hymen

A thin fold of mucous membrane that partially covers the external opening of the vagina. The hymen is a remnant of fetal development, with no known physiological function in postnatal life.

Hymenectomy

Hymenectomy is a procedure to remove or open part of the hymen, usually to treat an obstructed hymenal opening or another symptomatic abnormality.

Hymenolepiasis

Intestinal infection with dwarf tapeworms, especially Hymenolepis nana, acquired by ingesting eggs; it may cause abdominal symptoms, diarrhea, or be asymptomatic.

Hymenolepis Diminuta

A tapeworm that can infect people who accidentally swallow infected insects, usually in contaminated food. Infection may cause abdominal discomfort, diarrhea, or no symptoms and is treated with an antiparasitic medicine.

Hymenolepis Nana

A small tapeworm that spreads when microscopic eggs are swallowed, often through contaminated hands, food, or water. It can cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, poor appetite, or no symptoms and is treatable with antiparasitic medicine.

Hymenolepis Tapeworm Infection

Intestinal infection with Hymenolepis nana or H. diminuta, acquired by ingesting eggs or infected arthropods and causing variable gastrointestinal symptoms.

Hymenoptera

An insect order that includes bees, wasps, hornets, and ants; stings or bites can cause pain, allergy, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Hyoid Bone

U-shaped bone in the anterior neck at C3, unique for not directly articulating with any other bone. Suspended by muscles and the stylohyoid ligament. Provides attachment for suprahyoid (digastric, stylohyoid, mylohyoid, geniohyoid) and infrahyoid (sternohyoid, sternothyroid, thyrohyoid, omohyoid) muscles.

Hyoscine

A medicine that blocks muscarinic acetylcholine receptors. Depending on the preparation, it can prevent motion sickness, reduce spasms, or lessen secretions; dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, confusion, and urinary retention may occur.

Hyoscyamine

An antimuscarinic medicine that reduces smooth-muscle spasm and secretions; it may be used for selected gastrointestinal or urinary symptoms and can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, or confusion.

Hyperactivity

Excessive or developmentally inappropriate motor activity, restlessness, or difficulty remaining still; persistent impairment may occur in ADHD, mania, substance effects, or other conditions.

Hyperacusis

Reduced tolerance to ordinary environmental sounds, which may be perceived as excessively loud, painful, or distressing. It can occur with hearing disorders, migraine, head injury, neurologic conditions, or without an identifiable cause.

Hyperacute Rejection

A rare, immediate form of transplant rejection caused by preexisting antibodies against donor antigens, usually ABO blood-group or HLA antigens. Antibody activity injures graft blood vessels, causing clotting, loss of blood supply, and rapid graft failure within minutes to hours. Compatibility testing has made it uncommon.

Hyperadrenocorticism

Excess production or exposure to adrenal glucocorticoids, especially cortisol; in humans it causes Cushing syndrome, which may result from adrenal, pituitary, ectopic, or medication-related causes.

Hyperaemia

Increased blood flow to a tissue, making it look red or feel warm. It may be a normal response to activity or a response to inflammation or renewed blood flow after temporary blockage.

Hyperaesthesia

Unusually strong sensitivity to touch, pain, temperature, or other sensations. It may occur with nerve injury, inflammation, migraine, medicines, or disorders affecting the brain or spinal cord.

Hyperaldosteronism

Excess production of the adrenal hormone aldosterone. It can cause high blood pressure, low potas-

sium, muscle weakness, cramps, thirst, and frequent urination; an adrenal growth or overactivity of both glands may be responsible.

Hyperaldosteronism Complications

Beyond hypertension and hypokalemia, primary hyperaldosteronism causes target organ damage including left ventricular hypertrophy, fibrosis, stroke, coronary artery disease, atrial fibrillation, and chronic kidney disease. These complications occur at higher rates than in essential hypertension of similar severity.

Hyperalgesia

Feeling more pain than expected from something that normally hurts. It can happen with inflammation, nerve injury, changes in nervous-system pain processing, or opioid use; it differs from allodynia, which is pain from a normally painless touch.

Hyperammonemia

An abnormally high level of ammonia in the blood. It may result from severe liver disease, an inherited metabolic disorder, medicines, or other illness and can cause confusion, sleepiness, vomiting, seizures, coma, or brain swelling.

Hyperammonemia due to Ornithine Transcarbamylase Deficiency

An inherited urea-cycle disorder in which ornithine transcarbamylase deficiency causes ammonia to accumulate, potentially producing vomiting, confusion, seizures, brain swelling, or coma.

Hyperamylasemia

An elevated blood amylase concentration caused by pancreatic or salivary-gland disease, reduced clearance, macroamylasemia, or other conditions; it is not diagnostic of pancreatitis by itself.

Hyperargininemia

An inherited urea-cycle disorder caused by arginase deficiency, leading to high arginine and progressive spasticity, developmental impairment, seizures, or liver-related findings.

Alternate Names:

Arginase Deficiency

Hyperbaric

Having a pressure greater than the surrounding atmospheric pressure; hyperbaric oxygen therapy delivers oxygen at increased pressure for selected medical indications.

Hyperbaric Chamber

A pressurized chamber in which a person breathes oxygen or another gas at pressure above sea level, used for conditions such as decompression sickness, air embolism, and selected wounds.

Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy

Breathing oxygen inside a chamber pressurized above normal air pressure. The treatment increases oxygen dissolved in the blood and is used for selected problems such as carbon-monoxide poisoning, decompression sickness, and certain severe wounds or infections.

Hyperbilirubinaemia

Hyperbilirubinaemia is an abnormally high level of bilirubin in the blood, which can cause jaundice and may result from increased breakdown of red cells, liver disease, or blocked bile flow.

Hyperbilirubinemia

An abnormally high concentration of bilirubin in blood that may cause jaundice; causes include hemolysis, impaired liver processing, hepatocellular injury, and bile-duct obstruction.

Hypercalcaemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Hypercalcemia*.

Hypercalcemia

An abnormally high level of calcium in the blood. It may be caused by overactive parathyroid glands, cancer, medicines, or other conditions. Symptoms can include thirst, frequent urination, constipation, nausea, weakness, confusion, kidney stones, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Alternate Names:

High Blood Calcium; Hypercalcaemia; Elevated Serum Calcium

Hypercalcemia Of Malignancy

A high blood-calcium level caused by cancer. It may occur because the cancer releases substances that raise calcium or damages bone. Severe cases can cause thirst, vomiting, weakness, confusion, kidney injury, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Hypercalcemia-Supravalvar Aortic Stenosis

A combination of high blood calcium and narrowing above the aortic valve, classically associated with Williams syndrome; see *Williams Syndrome*.

Hypercalcemic Small Cell Ovarian Carcinoma

A rare, highly aggressive ovarian tumor in young patients, often associated with alterations in SMARCA4 and sometimes presenting with hypercalcemia.

Hypercalciuria

Excessive urinary calcium excretion, which can promote calcium kidney stones and, in some settings, bone mineral loss; evaluation considers diet, medications, kidney function, and endocrine causes.

Hypercapnia

An abnormally high level of carbon dioxide in arterial blood, usually defined as a $PaCO_2$ above 45 mmHg. It occurs when the lungs do not remove carbon dioxide as quickly as the body produces it, often because ventilation is inadequate. Causes include lung disease, impaired breathing muscles, chest-wall disorders, or reduced brain drive to breathe. Severe hypercapnia may cause headache, drowsiness, confusion, or reduced consciousness; it is not synonymous with respiratory acidosis.

Hypercementosis

Excessive deposition of cementum around a tooth root, producing a bulbous root contour that can complicate extraction but is often asymptomatic.

Hyperchloremia

A higher-than-normal level of chloride in the blood. Chloride is a charged particle from salt that helps balance body fluids and acids. High levels may occur with dehydration, kidney disease, or other changes in acid balance. The result is interpreted with other blood tests and a person's health.

Hyperchloremic Acidosis

A normal-anion-gap metabolic acidosis in which bicarbonate loss is accompanied by a relative rise in chloride. Causes include gastrointestinal bicarbonate loss, renal tubular acidosis, certain medicines, and excessive chloride administration.

Hypercholesterolaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Hypercholesterolemia*.

Hypercholesterolemia

An abnormally high concentration of cholesterol in the blood, often involving LDL or non-HDL cholesterol. It may be inherited or associated with other conditions or medicines; it usually causes no symptoms but contributes to atherosclerotic plaque formation and cardiovascular disease risk.

Hypercoagulable State

A condition in which blood clots more easily than usual, increasing the risk of deep-vein thrombosis, pulmonary embolism, stroke, or other clots. Causes may be inherited or acquired, including cancer, pregnancy, some medicines, inflammation, or prolonged immobility.

Hypercortisolism

Excessive exposure of body tissues to cortisol or related glucocorticoids, from internal overproduction or external sources such as glucocorticoid medicines. Sustained pathological excess can cause Cushing syndrome; temporary elevations associated with stress or illness do not necessarily meet criteria for the syndrome.

Hypercyanotic Tetralogy

A sudden episode of worsening blue or gray color, rapid breathing, distress, or faintness in a child with

Tetralogy of Fallot. It results from reduced blood flow to the lungs and is an emergency requiring immediate medical treatment.

Hyperelastic Skin

Skin that stretches farther than usual and recoils abnormally; generalized hyperextensibility may occur in connective-tissue disorders such as Ehlers-Danlos syndromes.

Hyperemesis

Excessive or persistent vomiting that can cause dehydration, abnormal body salts, weight loss, and poor nutrition. It may result from pregnancy, infection, medicines, digestive disease, brain illness, or other causes.

Hyperemesis Gravidarum

Severe nausea and vomiting during pregnancy that causes dehydration, weight loss, or abnormal body salts and prevents adequate food or fluid intake. It often begins early in pregnancy and may require fluids, nutrition, medicines, and hospital care.

Hyperemia

Increased blood flow to a tissue, causing redness and warmth; it may be an active physiologic response to exercise or inflammation or a reactive response after temporary ischemia.

Hyperemia Grade

A graded clinical or endoscopic estimate of tissue redness and vascular congestion, used to describe the severity of inflammation or mucosal irritation.

Hyperesthesia

Increased sensitivity to sensory stimulation—touch (tactile), pain (hyperalgesia), or other stimuli—so that normally non-painful or mildly painful stimuli produce exaggerated discomfort.

Hyperextension

Movement that extends a joint beyond its usual neutral or anatomical range, potentially stretching or tearing ligaments, capsules, muscles, or nerves.

Hyperfibrinogenemia

An abnormally high level of fibrinogen, a blood protein needed for clotting. It often rises with inflammation, infection, pregnancy, obesity, or estrogen exposure and may be associated with increased clotting risk.

Hyperflexion

Excessive bending of a joint beyond its normal range, which can injure ligaments, discs, muscles, or other supporting structures.

Hypergammaglobulinemia

An excess of antibody proteins in the blood. It may result from long-term infection, inflammation, liver disease, or an abnormal immune-cell growth; testing determines whether many antibody types or one type is increased.

Hyperglycaemia

An abnormally high level of glucose in the blood. It may cause thirst, frequent urination, tiredness, or blurred vision and, if severe or prolonged, can damage organs or cause an emergency.

Hyperglycemia

A higher-than-normal level of glucose in the blood. Severe short-term elevation can cause excessive urination, dehydration, and dangerous changes in body chemistry. Long-term elevation can damage the eyes, kidneys, nerves, heart, and blood vessels.

Hyperglycinemia

An abnormally high glycine concentration in blood, most notably in nonketotic hyperglycinemia, a disorder of glycine cleavage that can cause neonatal hypotonia, seizures, and developmental impairment.

Hypergonadotropic Hypogonadism

Reduced testicular or ovarian hormone production caused by gonad failure, with increased pituitary signals and possible infertility, absent periods, or delayed sexual development.

Hypergraphia

Excessive, compulsive, or unusually prolonged writing or drawing, sometimes associated with temporal-lobe epilepsy, mania, or other neurologic or psychiatric conditions.

Hyperhidrosis

Sweating in excess of what is needed to regulate body temperature. Primary hyperhidrosis often causes focal sweating of the palms, soles, underarms, or face in otherwise healthy people; secondary hyperhidrosis may result from medicines or an underlying disorder.

Hyperhomocysteinemia

An elevated blood homocysteine concentration associated with genetic enzyme defects, folate or vitamin B12 deficiency, kidney disease, medicines, and increased vascular or pregnancy-related risk in selected settings.

Hypericum Perforatum

St. John's wort, a plant used in some complementary products for depressive symptoms; it induces hepatic enzymes and transporters and can reduce the effects of many medicines or alter their blood levels.

Hyper-IgE Syndrome

A rare inherited immune disorder marked by very high levels of immunoglobulin E, eczema, and repeated skin or lung infections. Some forms also cause unusual bones, teeth, or blood vessels.

Hyper IgM Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Hyper-IgM Syndromes*.

Hyper-IgM Syndrome

See *Hyper-IgM Syndromes*.

Hyper-IgM Syndromes

Inherited immune disorders in which the body makes normal or high amounts of IgM antibodies but too little IgG, IgA, or IgE. People may develop repeated bacterial, viral, or fungal infections because antibody defenses do not mature normally.

Alternate Names:
HIGM

Hyperimmunization

Repeated or intensive exposure to an antigen, such as through vaccination or laboratory immunization, intended to produce a high antibody level. The term does not by itself describe an illness or harmful "over-vaccinated" state.

Hyperimmunoglobulin D Syndrome

A hereditary autoinflammatory disorder, usually caused by biallelic pathogenic variants in the mevalonate kinase gene. It causes recurrent episodes of fever, often with enlarged lymph nodes, abdominal symptoms, rash, and joint or muscle pain; it is the milder clinical form of mevalonate kinase deficiency.

Alternate Names:
HIDS

Hyperimmunoglobulin E Syndrome

A rare primary immunodeficiency characterized by very high IgE, eczema, recurrent skin and lung infections, and sometimes skeletal or dental abnormalities.

Hyperinsulinemia

An abnormally high insulin level in the blood, often caused by insulin resistance, excess insulin medicine, or rarely an insulin-producing tumor. It may occur with normal or low glucose.

Hyperinsulinism

Excessive insulin secretion or action causing recurrent or persistent hypoglycemia; causes include congenital disorders, tumors, medications, and critical illness.

Hyperkalaemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Hyperkalemia*.

Hyperkalemia

An abnormally high concentration of potassium in the blood. Causes include impaired kidney excre-

tion, medicines, tissue breakdown, or movement of potassium out of cells; haemolysis of a blood sample can produce pseudohyperkalemia. Hyperkalemia can disturb cardiac conduction and cause arrhythmias. ECG findings vary and do not reliably indicate the serum potassium concentration.

Alternate Names:
High Blood Potassium; Hyperkalaemia; Elevated Serum Potassium

Hyperkalemic Periodic Paralysis

An inherited muscle disorder causing repeated attacks of weakness or temporary paralysis. Attacks may follow rest after exercise, stress, or potassium-rich food and usually improve between episodes.

Hyperkeratosis

Thickening of the outer keratin layer of skin or mucosa, producing callus, scale, or rough plaques in response to friction, inflammation, infection, inherited disorders, or other causes.

Hyperkeratosis of Palm

Alternate name; see *Palmoplantar Hyperkeratosis*.

Hyperkeratosis of Palms

Alternate name; see *Palmoplantar Hyperkeratosis*.

Hyperkinesia

Excessive or involuntary movement, such as chorea, dystonia, tics, or tremor, resulting from abnormal activity in motor-control circuits or from drugs and other diseases.

Hyperlipasaemia

An abnormally high blood lipase concentration, often associated with pancreatic inflammation but also seen with kidney failure, gastrointestinal disease, medications, and other conditions.

Hyperlipidaemia

An abnormally high level of fats in the blood, including cholesterol or triglycerides. It may have no symptoms but can increase the risk of artery disease, heart attack, stroke, or pancreatitis.

Hyperlipidemia

Too much cholesterol or triglyceride fat in the blood. It usually causes no symptoms but can build up in artery walls, increasing the risk of heart attack and stroke; inherited disorders and other illnesses, medicines, diet, or alcohol can contribute.

Hyperlipoproteinemia

An excess of one or more lipoproteins in blood, producing high cholesterol or triglycerides and increasing risk of atherosclerosis, pancreatitis, or inherited lipid disease.

Hyperlordosis

Exaggerated inward curvature of the lumbar spine, often producing a swayback appearance and sometimes associated with pain, muscular imbalance, obesity, pregnancy, or structural spinal disease.

Hyperlordotic Posture

An exaggerated inward curvature of the lumbar spine, often producing increased anterior pelvic tilt and a prominent lower-back arch.

Hyperlysinemia

An inherited metabolic abnormality with elevated lysine in blood caused by altered lysine degradation; many people have few symptoms, but some have developmental or neurologic findings.

Hypermagnesemia

An abnormally high concentration of magnesium in the blood, often related to kidney failure or excessive magnesium intake; severe cases can cause weakness, low blood pressure, depressed reflexes, or arrhythmias.

Hypermetropia

Long-sightedness, in which the eye focuses light behind the retina instead of on it. Close objects may look blurred, and children may develop eye strain or an inward-turning eye.

Alternate Names:
Hyperopia; Farsightedness; Long-sightedness

Hypermobile Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome

An inherited connective-tissue disorder marked by unusually flexible or unstable joints, long-term muscle or joint pain, and other variable features involving the skin, automatic body functions, or digestion.

Hypermobile Joints

Joints that move farther than usual. This may cause no problems, or may lead to pain, repeated dislocations, sprains, fatigue, or joint instability.

Hypermobility

Greater-than-usual movement of one or more joints. It may be a harmless trait, but when associated with pain, instability, dislocations, fatigue, or other features it may be part of a hypermobility spectrum disorder.

Hypermobility Spectrum Disorder

A condition involving joint hypermobility together with symptoms such as pain, joint instability, soft-tissue injury, or fatigue, without meeting the criteria for another defined connective-tissue disorder.

Hypermobility Syndrome

Excessive joint movement associated with pain, instability, fatigue, or other symptoms; evaluation distinguishes generalized joint hypermobility from a defined hypermobility spectrum disorder or hypermobile Ehlers-Danlos syndrome.

Hypermotility

Abnormally rapid or excessive movement of an organ, especially the digestive tract. It may cause cramping, urgency, diarrhea, or poor absorption and can result from infection, medicines, inflammation, or other disorders.

Hypernatraemia

An abnormally high level of sodium in the blood, usually because the body has too little water. It may cause thirst, weakness, confusion, seizures, or coma.

Hypernatremia

A high blood-sodium level, usually because the body has lost too much water or cannot obtain enough. It can cause intense thirst, weakness, confusion, seizures, or coma.

Hypernatremia Result

A high blood sodium result, usually reflecting too little free water relative to body sodium; severity and rate of onset determine neurologic risk and the urgency and speed of correction.

Hyperopia

Alternate name; see *Hypermetropia*.

Hyperornithinemia

An elevated blood ornithine concentration caused by defects in ornithine metabolism or transport, including disorders that can produce retinal degeneration or neurologic disease.

Hyperosmolar

Having more dissolved particles than another fluid. When blood becomes too concentrated, water moves out of cells and can cause dehydration, confusion, or other nervous-system problems.

Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State

A life-threatening condition in which very high blood glucose causes severe dehydration and concentrated body fluids, usually with little or no ketone buildup. It may cause extreme thirst, weakness, confusion, seizures, or coma.

Hyperosmolar Non-Ketotic Coma

A life-threatening complication of very high blood glucose, usually in type 2 diabetes, causing severe dehydration and sometimes confusion, seizures, or coma.

Hyperostosis

Abnormal excessive formation or thickening of bone, which may be localized or widespread and may occur in skeletal dysplasias, inflammation, endocrine disease, or medication effects.

Hyperoxaluria

An excess of oxalate in the urine, which can combine with calcium to form kidney stones or calcium deposits. Severe inherited forms can progressively damage the kidneys.

Hyperoxia

Exposure to an abnormally high oxygen concentration or tissue oxygen level, which can cause oxygen toxicity, absorption atelectasis, retinal injury in premature infants, or lung injury depending on dose and duration.

Hyperparakeratosis

Thickening of the outer skin layer in which cells retain their nuclei instead of fully maturing. It may produce rough scale and can result from irritation, inflammation, infection, or an inherited skin disorder.

Hyperparathyroid Bone Disease

Bone changes caused by prolonged high levels of parathyroid hormone. The hormone can increase bone breakdown, lowering bone strength and raising fracture risk; severe long-standing disease can cause osteitis fibrosa cystica.

Hyperparathyroidism

A disorder in which the parathyroid glands release too much parathyroid hormone. Primary hyperparathyroidism usually begins in a gland and often raises blood calcium; secondary hyperparathyroidism is a response to problems such as chronic kidney disease or vitamin D deficiency and may have normal or low calcium. Tertiary hyperparathyroidism can develop after long-standing secondary disease.

Hyperpathia

An unusually strong and sometimes delayed pain response to a painful stimulus. It may occur after nerve injury or with disorders that change how the nervous system processes pain.

Hyperphagia

An unusually strong or excessive appetite. It can occur with diabetes, some genetic or brain disorders, certain medicines, or mental health conditions.

Hyperphosphatemia

A high phosphate level in the blood, most often caused by kidney disease. It can disturb calcium balance, weaken bones, and contribute to calcium deposits in blood vessels or soft tissues.

Hyperpigmentation

Darkening of an area of skin because the body makes or stores more pigment there. Causes include sun exposure, inflammation, injury, medicines, hormone disorders, and some skin or internal diseases.

Hyperpituitarism

Excess production of one or more pituitary hormones, most often by a pituitary tumor. Growth-hormone excess can cause acromegaly in adults or gigantism in children; excess adrenocorticotropic hormone can cause Cushing disease; and excess prolactin can cause galactorrhea or reduced fertility.

Hyperplasia

An increase in the number of cells in a tissue or organ, which may make it larger. It can be a normal response or result from disease, hormones, or other stimuli.

Hyperplastic Polyp

A usually noncancerous overgrowth of lining cells, often in the colon or rectum, whose cancer risk depends on size, number, and location.

Hyperpnea

Breathing that is deeper, and sometimes faster, than normal, increasing air movement and occurring with exercise, illness, metabolic changes, or anxiety.

Hyperpnoea

Breathing that is deeper or faster than usual to meet increased demand for oxygen or remove extra carbon dioxide. It may occur during exercise, fever, anxiety, or lung, heart, or metabolic illness.

Hyperpolarization

An electrical change that makes a nerve or muscle cell less likely to send a signal. It occurs when the inside of the cell becomes more electrically negative after certain ion channels open.

Hyperprolactinaemia

An abnormally elevated concentration of prolactin in the blood. Causes include medicines, pregnancy, hypothyroidism, pituitary tumors, and other disorders.

Hyperprolactinemia

An abnormally high level of prolactin, a hormone that supports milk production, in the blood. Levels normally rise during pregnancy and breastfeeding; other causes include certain medicines, an underactive thyroid, kidney disease, or a prolactin-producing pituitary tumor. It may cause milk discharge, irregular or absent periods, low sex drive, erectile problems, or infertility; some people have no symptoms.

Hyperproteinemia

An abnormally high total blood-protein concentration, usually from dehydration, chronic inflammation, or a monoclonal immunoglobulin disorder.

Hyperpyrexia

An extreme elevation of body temperature, generally above 41.5 °C, that can result from severe infection, heatstroke, malignant hyperthermia, drug toxicity, or other life-threatening conditions.

Hyperreactio Luteinalis

Bilateral ovarian enlargement with multiple thecalutein cysts caused by an exaggerated response to human chorionic gonadotropin, usually during pregnancy or with trophoblastic disease.

Hyperreflexia

Exaggerated or overactive deep-tendon (stretch) reflexes. It is a neurologic sign, not a diagnosis, and often reflects impaired descending upper-motor-neuron control; it may occur with spasticity, clonus, or an extensor plantar response. Distribution and associated findings help distinguish central nervous-system disease from systemic or toxic causes.

Hypersensitivity

An exaggerated or inappropriate immune response to an antigen, ranging from a mild reaction to anaphylaxis.

Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis

Lung inflammation caused by repeated breathing of substances such as mold, bird proteins, or other workplace dusts. It may cause cough, breathlessness, fever, or fatigue and can lead to permanent lung scarring if exposure continues.

Hypersensitivity Reactions

Inappropriate or excessive immune responses causing tissue damage or disease.

Hypersensitivity Type I

An immediate allergic reaction in which immunoglobulin E antibodies activate mast cells after exposure to an allergen. Symptoms can include itching, hives, wheezing, vomiting, swelling, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Hypersensitivity Type II

An immune reaction in which IgG or IgM antibodies attach to targets on cells or tissues and recruit other immune mechanisms that injure them. Examples include some drug reactions and autoimmune blood-cell destruction.

Hypersensitivity Type III

An immune reaction in which clusters of antibodies and foreign or self proteins settle in tissues or blood vessels, causing inflammation and injury. It can affect the skin, joints, kidneys, or blood vessels.

Hypersensitivity Type IV

A delayed immune reaction driven by T cells rather than antibodies. It usually develops 48 to 72 hours after exposure and can cause contact dermatitis, some drug rashes, or inflammation around an infection.

Hypersensitivity Vasculitis

Inflammation of small blood vessels, usually in the skin, often triggered by an infection, medicine, or immune reaction. It commonly causes raised purple spots or bruising on the legs.

Hypersomnia

Being very sleepy during the day or sleeping much longer than usual even after enough sleep. It can be caused by sleep disorders, medicines, depression, substance use, or other illness; it is different from feeling tired without wanting to sleep.

Hypersomnia Disorder

Excessive daytime sleepiness or prolonged nighttime sleep episodes not explained by inadequate sleep duration; see *Hypersomnia* and *Idiopathic Hypersomnia*.

Hypersplenism

A condition in which an enlarged or overactive spleen removes blood cells too quickly. It may lower red cells, white cells, platelets, or all three and can cause anemia, infections, or easy bleeding.

Hypertelorism

An unusually wide distance between the eyes because the bony eye sockets are farther apart than usual. It may be present from birth or occur as part of a genetic or developmental condition.

Hypertension

A chronic cardiovascular condition commonly known as high blood pressure, in which the long-term force of circulating blood against artery walls is consistently elevated. Because it typically produces no noticeable symptoms, it is often called a 'silent killer.' Over time, unmanaged high blood pressure strains the heart and blood vessels, dramatically increasing the risk of heart attacks, heart failure, strokes, kidney disease, and vision loss.

Alternate Names:
High Blood Pressure; Arterial Hypertension; Essential Hypertension

Hypertension and Pregnancy

High blood pressure before or during pregnancy ranges from chronic or gestational hypertension to preeclampsia and eclampsia. It can affect the brain, kidneys, liver, placenta, and fetal growth; blood-pressure monitoring, appropriate medicines, laboratory tests, and fetal surveillance are essential.

Hypertension and the Kidney

High blood pressure can damage renal arteries and glomeruli, while kidney disease can activate salt-retaining and hormonal pathways that raise blood pressure. Their interaction can accelerate chronic kidney disease, so both blood pressure and kidney function require monitoring.

Hypertension In Anesthesia

Abnormally high blood pressure during or around an operation. Pain, inadequate anesthesia, low oxygen, high carbon dioxide, shivering, bladder fullness, or stopping certain medicines may contribute and increase the risk of bleeding, heart injury, or stroke.

Hypertension With Chronic Kidney Disease

Alternate wording; see *Hypertension and the Kidney*.

Hypertensive

Having blood pressure that remains above the accepted range for the person's age, health, and measurement setting, increasing risk of heart, brain, kidney, or vessel disease.

Hypertensive Cerebellar Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the cerebellum caused by rupture of a vessel damaged by high blood pressure.

Hypertensive Crisis

A dangerously high blood pressure. When it causes new organ injury, such as stroke, heart failure, kidney injury, or vision loss, it is a hypertensive emergency requiring controlled blood-pressure treatment.

Hypertensive Emergency

A severe rise in blood pressure that is causing new injury to the brain, heart, kidneys, eyes, or major blood vessels. Symptoms may include chest pain, breathlessness, weakness, confusion, seizures, or vision loss; treatment involves controlled blood-pressure reduction and management of organ injury.

Hypertensive Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction caused by a sudden, severe rise in blood pressure. Headache, confusion, seizures, vision changes, or reduced consciousness may occur; treatment involves controlled blood-pressure reduction.

Hypertensive Heart Disease

Changes or damage to the heart caused by long-term high blood pressure. The heart has to work harder to pump against the increased pressure, which can make its muscle thicken or stiffen and may eventually lead to heart failure or abnormal heart rhythms.

Hypertensive Intracerebral Hemorrhage

Bleeding into brain tissue after a blood vessel weakened by high blood pressure breaks, potentially causing sudden headache, weakness, confusion, unconsciousness, or death.

Hypertensive Kidney Disease

Kidney damage associated with long-term high blood pressure. It may lead to protein in the urine and gradually reduced kidney function; diabetes, other kidney diseases, and inherited risk can cause similar findings.

Alternate Names:
Hypertensive Nephropathy

Hypertensive Nephrosclerosis

Scarring and narrowing of small kidney blood vessels caused by long-term high blood pressure. It can gradually reduce kidney function and may cause protein in the urine; controlling blood pressure helps slow progression.

Hypertensive Retinopathy

Damage to the retina's small blood vessels caused by high blood pressure. Findings may include narrowed arteries, changes where arteries cross veins, retinal bleeding, cotton-wool spots, and hard exudates; severe cases may cause swelling of the optic disc.

Hypertensive Urgency

A markedly high blood pressure without clear evidence of new organ injury. Treatment is generally adjusted gradually; sudden excessive reduction can impair blood flow to organs.

Hyperthermia

An abnormally high core body temperature caused by excess heat production or impaired heat loss without a rise in the hypothalamic temperature set point. Causes include environmental heat, exertion, medicines, endocrine or metabolic disorders, and impaired sweating. It differs from fever, in which the temperature set point rises; severe hyperthermia can cause confusion, seizures, organ injury, or death.

Hyperthermia For Treating Cancer

A cancer treatment that deliberately heats a tumor or part of the body, sometimes with radiation or medicines, to damage cancer cells or make other treatment work better.

Hyperthermia In Anesthesia

An elevated body temperature during or after anesthesia. Causes include fever from infection, drug reactions, thyroid storm, serotonin syndrome, and malignant hyperthermia, a rare emergency with muscle rigidity and rising carbon dioxide. Evaluation distinguishes fever from true hyperthermia, in which the hypothalamic temperature set point is not raised.

Hyperthermic Intraperitoneal Chemotherapy

Heated cancer medicine circulated through the abdominal cavity during surgery after visible tumor is removed. It is used for selected cancers that have spread across the abdominal lining and can cause

infection, bleeding, organ injury, or other serious complications.

Hyperthyroidism

A condition in which the thyroid makes too much thyroid hormone. It may cause weight loss, sweating, heat intolerance, shaking, anxiety, diarrhea, or a fast or irregular heartbeat. Common causes include Graves disease and overactive thyroid nodules.

Alternate Names:
Overactive Thyroid

Hyperthyroxinemia

An abnormally high concentration of circulating thyroxine, caused by hyperthyroidism, thyroiditis, medication, binding-protein changes, or assay interference; symptoms and TSH clarify the cause.

Hypertonia

Abnormally increased muscle tightness or resistance when a limb is moved. It may cause stiffness, abnormal posture, spasms, or limited movement and can result from brain, spinal-cord, or other nervous-system disorders.

Hypertonic Saline

Saline containing more sodium than normal blood, commonly given through a vein for severe symptoms from dangerously low blood sodium or selected urgent conditions. Close monitoring is required because correcting sodium too quickly can cause serious brain injury.

Hypertonic Saline Inhalation

Inhaling a salty mist through a nebulizer to draw water into airway mucus and make it easier to clear. It may help some people with cystic fibrosis or bronchiectasis, but can briefly narrow the airways; use is generally guided by a respiratory treatment plan.

Hypertonic Solution

A solution with greater effective osmotic concentration than the fluid with which it is compared, causing water to move out of cells across a semipermeable membrane.

Hypertrichosis

Excessive hair growth in any body area, in a localized or generalized pattern, that is not limited to the androgen-dependent male pattern seen in hirsutism. It may be present from birth or develop later because of inherited conditions, medicines, nutritional or metabolic disease, skin disorders, or rarely cancer. New, widespread, or rapidly progressive growth can suggest an underlying cause.

Hypertriglyceridemia

An abnormally high level of triglycerides, a type of fat, in the blood. Causes include diabetes, obesity, alcohol, some medicines, and inherited disorders. Very high levels increase the risk of acute pancreatitis and require medical management.

Hypertrophic

Relating to hypertrophy, an enlargement of cells or tissue that increases the size of an organ or structure.

Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy

An inherited heart condition in which the muscular wall of the heart—especially the wall dividing the lower chambers (the septum)—becomes abnormally thick and stiff without an obvious cause like high blood pressure. This excessive thickening makes it harder for the heart to fill with and pump blood, and can obstruct blood flow exiting the heart. While many people have no symptoms, it can cause chest pain, shortness of breath, dizziness, and dangerous heart rhythm problems.

Alternate Names:
HCM; Hypertrophic Obstructive Cardiomyopathy; HOCM

Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy Genetics

Many cases result from an inherited change in a gene for a heart-muscle protein, commonly MYH7 or MYBPC3. The condition can run in families, so genetic counseling and screening of close relatives may form part of family risk assessment.

Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy Treatment

Management may include medicines to relieve symptoms, treatment of arrhythmias or obstruction, an

implantable defibrillator for selected patients, and surgery or ablation when indicated. Treatment is guided by symptoms, anatomy, risk, and specialist assessment.

Hypertrophic Gastritis

Unusually thick folds in the stomach lining caused by overgrowth or swelling of its glands. Ménétrier disease is one type; other causes and effects vary. Some forms can lead to protein loss, nausea, or a higher risk of stomach cancer.

Hypertrophic Gastropathy

Thickening of the stomach lining, often with enlarged folds. It can result from several conditions, including Ménétrier disease; see also *Hypertrophic Gastritis*.

Hypertrophic Myocardiopathy

Alternate name; see *Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy*.

Hypertrophic Obstructive Cardiomyopathy

A form of hypertrophic cardiomyopathy in which the thickened heart muscle causes dynamic narrowing of the left-ventricular outflow tract, the passage through which blood leaves the heart. The obstruction may be present at rest or appear with exercise or other changes in heart loading and contraction. It can cause breathlessness, chest pain, dizziness, or fainting.

Hypertrophic Osteoarthropathy

A syndrome of digital clubbing, periosteal new-bone formation, and joint pain or swelling. It may be primary and inherited or secondary to conditions such as lung cancer, chronic lung infection, cyanotic heart disease, or inflammatory disorders.

Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis

Thickening of the muscle at the stomach outlet, usually in the first weeks of life, that narrows the passage into the small intestine. It causes repeated, forceful vomiting after feeds, usually without green bile. A baby may still seem hungry but lose weight or become dehydrated. Ultrasound is commonly used to find it; an operation called pyloromyotomy loosens the narrowed opening.

Alternate Names:
Infantile Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis; Infantile Pyloric Stenosis; Congenital Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis

Hypertrophic Scar

A raised, thick scar that stays within the boundaries of the original wound. It forms when the body makes too much scar tissue during healing, often after burns, surgery, or injury. Unlike a keloid, it does not grow beyond the wound edges and may become flatter over time.

Hypertrophy

Enlargement of a tissue or organ because its individual cells become larger. It may develop in response to increased workload, hormones, disease, or other stimulation.

Hypertropia

Vertical misalignment of the eyes in which one eye deviates upward relative to the other, causing double vision, eye strain, or abnormal head posture.

Hyperuricemia

An abnormally high concentration of uric acid in the blood, which may be asymptomatic or contribute to gout and uric-acid kidney stones.

Hyperventilating

Breathing faster or deeper than the body needs, lowering carbon dioxide in the blood. It may cause light-headedness, tingling, chest tightness, or fainting and can result from anxiety or serious illness.

Hyperventilation

Abnormally rapid, deep, or otherwise excessive breathing that removes more carbon dioxide than the body produces, often causing respiratory alkalosis. It may cause breathlessness, dizziness, tingling, chest tightness, muscle spasms, or fainting. Anxiety or panic can trigger it, but new or severe hyperventilation may reflect heart or lung disease, infection, bleeding, metabolic illness, or another emergency.

Hyperventilation Syndrome

Repeated overbreathing, often during stress or panic, that lowers carbon dioxide in the blood and causes breathlessness, chest tightness, dizziness, tingling, palpitations, or hand and foot spasms. Similar symptoms can arise from heart or lung disease.

Hypervigilance

A state of excessive alertness to possible threat, often accompanied by scanning, startle, irritability, and sleep difficulty in anxiety, trauma-related disorders, stimulant use, or medical illness.

Hyperviscosity Syndrome

A set of symptoms and signs caused by blood that is abnormally thick, usually from very high levels of an immunoglobulin paraprotein or of red or white blood cells. It can complicate Waldenström macroglobulinemia, multiple myeloma, polycythemia, leukemia, or severe infection. Features include bleeding from the nose or gums, blurred or lost vision from retinal changes, headache, dizziness, confusion, stroke-like symptoms, or heart failure; severe cases are an emergency managed with plasma exchange while the underlying disease is treated.

Hypervitaminosis A

Illness caused by too much vitamin A, usually from supplements or medicines. It may cause headache, nausea, dry skin, hair loss, liver injury, bone pain, or birth defects during pregnancy.

Hypervitaminosis D

Illness caused by too much vitamin D, leading to high blood calcium. It may cause nausea, vomiting, thirst, frequent urination, weakness, kidney stones, confusion, or kidney damage.

Hypervolaemia

An excess of blood or body fluid. It may cause rapid weight gain, swelling, breathlessness, raised neck veins, or high blood pressure, especially with heart, kidney, or liver disease.

Hypervolemia

Too much fluid in the bloodstream or body tissues. It may cause rapid weight gain, swelling, breathlessness, raised neck veins, or high blood pressure and can occur with heart, kidney, or liver disease.

Hypha

A branching tubular filament that forms the basic structural unit of most molds and many fungi; networks of hyphae form a mycelium and may invade tissue in fungal disease.

Hyphema

Blood collecting in the front part of the eye, usually after an injury. It may cause pain, blurred vision, light sensitivity, or increased eye pressure; complications can threaten vision.

Hypnagogic

Occurring during the transition from wakefulness to sleep. Hypnagogic sensations or hallucinations can be benign, but frequent or distressing episodes may occur with narcolepsy, sleep deprivation, medicines, or other sleep and neurologic disorders.

Hypnagogic Hallucinations

Vivid sights, sounds, sensations, or feelings that occur while a person is falling asleep. They are often harmless but may be linked to sleep deprivation, narcolepsy, medicines, or other sleep disorders.

Hypnic Headache

A rare primary headache that repeatedly awakens a person during sleep, usually in later life and often at a similar time each night.

Hypnogram

A chart showing when a person is awake and in each sleep stage during a recording. It is commonly made from a sleep study and helps show sleep timing, awakenings, and stage patterns.

Alternate Names:
Sleep Architecture Diagram; Polysomnographic Hypnogram

Hypnosis

A state of focused attention and deep relaxation in

which a person may respond more readily to guided suggestions. It is not sleep or loss of control; clinical hypnosis is conducted by a trained professional.

Hypnotherapy

Hypnotherapy uses focused attention and guided suggestion as an adjunct to care for selected problems such as pain, anxiety, or unwanted habits.

Hypnotic

A medicine used mainly to help a person fall asleep or stay asleep. Some hypnotics can cause next-day drowsiness, falls, dependence, or slowed breathing, especially when combined with alcohol or other sedatives. Not all sedatives are used as sleep medicines.

Hypoactive Sexual Desire Disorder

Persistently low or absent sexual interest that causes personal distress or relationship difficulty. Desire can be affected by medicines, hormones, illness, pain, mood, stress, trauma, or relationship factors, so assessment looks for the underlying cause.

Hypoadrenalism

Insufficient adrenal-cortex hormone production, especially cortisol and sometimes aldosterone; primary disease can cause fatigue, weight loss, low blood pressure, hyperpigmentation, and adrenal crisis.

Hypoalbuminemia

An abnormally low blood albumin concentration caused by reduced production, inflammation, kidney or gastrointestinal loss, or severe malnutrition; it can contribute to edema and alter drug binding.

Hypoalphalipoproteinemias

Disorders with low HDL-related apolipoprotein levels, which may impair reverse cholesterol transport and increase cardiovascular risk depending on the cause and overall lipid profile.

Hypoblast

The inner cell layer of the early embryonic disc that contributes to the yolk-sac lining and helps establish the embryonic body axes during gastrulation.

Hypocalcaemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Hypocalcemia*.

Hypocalcemia

An abnormally low level of calcium in the blood, especially the ionized form that is available for body functions. It can cause tingling around the mouth or fingers, muscle cramps, and, when severe, seizures or abnormal heart rhythms. Causes include low parathyroid hormone, vitamin D deficiency, kidney disease, low magnesium, and some medicines. Low albumin can lower total measured calcium while ionized calcium remains normal.

Alternate Names:
Low Blood Calcium; Hypocalcaemia

Hypocapnia

An abnormally low level of carbon dioxide in the blood, usually because a person is breathing too fast or deeply. Causes include anxiety, pain, low oxygen, lung disease, pregnancy, or excessive ventilator support.

Hypochloremia

A lower-than-normal level of chloride in the blood. Chloride is a charged particle from salt that helps balance body fluids and acids. Low levels may follow prolonged vomiting or heavy sweating, or occur with some medicines, kidney problems, or other fluid-balance disorders. It may occur with metabolic alkalosis.

Hypochloremic Alkalosis

A chloride-depletion form of metabolic alkalosis, commonly associated with vomiting, gastric suction, or diuretic use. Low chloride reflects loss of hydrogen and chloride ions and helps guide assessment of the cause and response to treatment.

Hypochlorite

A chemical form of chlorine used in disinfectants and bleach. It can kill many germs, but swallowing it or getting concentrated solutions in the eyes, lungs, or skin can cause serious injury.

Hypocholesterolemia

An unusually low blood cholesterol concentration caused by malnutrition, malabsorption, hyperthyroidism, chronic illness, liver disease, or inherited lipid disorders.

Hypochondria

Older, nonspecific term for excessive fear or worry about having an illness. Depending on a person's symptoms, a current diagnosis may be illness anxiety disorder or somatic symptom disorder.

Hypochondroplasia

An inherited disorder of bone growth that causes short stature and shortened arms and legs, usually less severely than achondroplasia. People may have broad hands, increased inward curvature of the lower back, or limited elbow movement, while facial appearance and intelligence are often typical. It is usually caused by a change in the *FGFR3* gene.

Alternate Names:
HCH

Hypochromia

Reduced hemoglobin color in red blood cells, seen as increased central pallor on a blood smear and commonly associated with iron deficiency or thalassemia.

Hypochromic Anaemia

Hypochromic anaemia is anemia in which red blood cells contain too little hemoglobin and appear unusually pale, commonly because of iron deficiency or thalassemia.

Hypochromic Anemia

Anemia in which red cells contain too little hemoglobin and appear pale, most often because of iron deficiency, thalassemia, chronic disease, or sideroblastic disorders.

Hypocitraturia

Low urinary citrate excretion, which reduces inhibition of calcium-crystal formation and increases risk of calcium kidney stones; potassium citrate may be used when clinically appropriate.

Hypocupremia

An abnormally low copper concentration in blood or tissues, caused by inadequate intake, malabsorption, excess zinc, or inherited disorders, and potentially producing anemia, neutropenia, or neurologic disease.

Hypodermic Needle

A hollow needle designed to inject medicines or withdraw fluid through the skin, with gauge and length selected according to the substance, route, body site, and patient.

Hypodermis

The layer of fat and loose tissue beneath the skin. It cushions the body, stores energy, helps conserve heat, and contains blood vessels, nerves, and lymph channels.

Hypodontia

A condition present from birth in which one or more permanent teeth fail to develop. It most often affects wisdom teeth, upper side incisors, or second premolars and may affect chewing, appearance, or tooth alignment.

Hypoechoic

Describing a structure that returns fewer ultrasound echoes and appears darker than the surrounding reference tissue. This relative appearance can occur for many reasons and does not by itself identify the cause.

Hypoesthesia

Reduced sensitivity to touch, temperature, pain, or other sensations. It may result from nerve compression, neuropathy, spinal disease, stroke, injury, or other neurologic conditions; sudden or spreading numbness can occur with acute neurologic disease.

Hypogalactia

Insufficient breast-milk production for an infant's needs, caused by ineffective milk removal, hormonal

or breast disorders, medications, illness, or other feeding difficulties.

Hypogammaglobulinemia

Lower-than-normal levels of antibodies (immunoglobulins) in the blood. It may be inherited or develop when illness, medicines, or protein loss reduce antibody production or increase antibody loss. Some people have repeated infections, especially in the lungs, sinuses, or ears; others have few symptoms.

Hypogastric Region

The lower central area of the abdomen, just above the pubic bone. It overlies the bladder and parts of the bowel and reproductive organs; pain or a lump there may arise from urinary, intestinal, or pelvic disease.

Hypoglossal Canal

A paired bony opening situated in the occipital bone above the anterolateral margin of the foramen magnum, directed laterally and forward to transmit the hypoglossal nerve (cranial nerve XII) and a meningeal branch of the ascending pharyngeal artery out of the posterior cranial fossa.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Condyloid Foramen

Hypoglossal Nerve

Cranial nerve XII, which supplies the muscles that move the tongue; a lesion causes tongue weakness, wasting, and deviation toward the affected side on protrusion.

Hypoglossal Nerve Injury

Damage to the nerve that controls tongue movement. It may follow skull-base injury, surgery, a tumor, or infection and can cause tongue weakness, wasting, or deviation when the tongue is extended.

Hypoglossal Nerve Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of the hypoglossal nerve (CN XII), leading to ipsilateral tongue weakness, atrophy, and fasciculations. Causes include tumors at the skull base or in the hypoglossal canal, surgical injury, or central lesions. Unilateral palsy causes the tongue to deviate toward the affected side on protrusion.

Hypoglycaemia

An abnormally low blood-glucose level. It may cause sweating, shaking, hunger, palpitations, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness and is especially associated with diabetes medicines, missed meals, or heavy alcohol use.

Hypoglycemia

An abnormally low blood-glucose concentration that may cause sweating, tremor, palpitations, hunger, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness. Causes include glucose-lowering medicines, missed meals, alcohol, and critical illness. Treatment depends on the person's ability to swallow and the cause; severe or recurrent episodes can signal serious illness.

Hypoglycemia In Diabetes

Blood glucose that falls too low in a person with diabetes, usually below 70 mg/dL. It may cause sweating, shaking, hunger, confusion, or fainting; severe episodes can prevent self-treatment and require assistance from another person.

Hypoglycemia Unawareness

Failure to feel the usual warning signs of low blood glucose, such as shaking, sweating, or a racing heartbeat. It can occur after repeated low readings or long-standing diabetes and increases the risk of severe hypoglycemia.

Hypoglycemic

Relating to an abnormally low blood glucose level, or describing a medicine that lowers blood glucose.

Hypogonadism

Reduced function of the testes or ovaries, causing low sex-hormone levels and impaired production of sperm or eggs. It may lead to delayed puberty, absent periods, infertility, low sexual desire, hot flashes, reduced muscle or bone strength, or other symptoms.

Hypogonadism In Men

Low testosterone caused by reduced testicular function or by a problem in the brain signals that control the testes. It may cause low sexual desire, erectile problems, infertility, low energy, reduced muscle, or weak bones.

Hypogonadism In Women

Reduced ovarian hormone production, which may cause absent or irregular periods, hot flashes, vaginal dryness, infertility, low sexual desire, or loss of bone strength. Causes include ovarian failure, pituitary disease, some medicines, severe illness, or surgery.

Hypogonadotropic Hypogonadism

Low production of sex hormones because the brain or pituitary gland does not send enough stimulating signals to the testes or ovaries. It may cause delayed puberty, absent periods, infertility, low sexual desire, or reduced testosterone. Causes include genetic conditions, pituitary disease, obesity, medicines, or severe illness.

Hypohidrosis

Reduced or absent sweating. It can make it difficult for the body to cool itself and increase the risk of overheating. Causes include nerve disorders, skin damage, medicines, dehydration, and inherited conditions.

Hypokalaemia

British spelling of Hypokalemia; see Hypokalemia.

Hypokalemia

An abnormally low level of potassium in the blood, often caused by vomiting, diarrhea, diuretics, hormone disorders, or movement of potassium into cells. It may cause weakness, cramps, constipation, or dangerous heart-rhythm changes.

Hypokalemic Periodic Paralysis

An inherited disorder causing repeated attacks of muscle weakness or paralysis when blood potassium falls. Attacks often begin after rest following exercise or after a high-carbohydrate meal, while strength may be normal between attacks.

Hypokinesia

Reduced or slowed movement. It may cause small steps, less facial expression, reduced arm swing, or small handwriting and commonly occurs in Parkinson disease or other disorders affecting movement control.

Hypolipidemic Agents

Medicines that lower cholesterol or triglycerides, including statins, ezetimibe, fibrates, bile-acid sequestrants, niacin, and selected injectable therapies.

Hypolipoproteinemia

An abnormally low concentration of one or more blood lipoproteins, caused by inherited disorders, malabsorption, malnutrition, liver disease, or other systemic illness.

Hypomagnesaemia

An abnormally low level of magnesium in the blood. It may cause tremor, muscle cramps, weakness, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms and can result from diarrhea, poor intake, alcohol use, or certain medicines.

Hypomagnesemia

A low level of magnesium in the blood, often caused by diarrhea, poor nutrition, alcohol use, kidney loss, or some medicines. It may cause tremor, cramps, weakness, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Hypomania

A distinct period of unusually elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy or activity lasting at least four consecutive days. It may involve reduced need for sleep, rapid speech, racing thoughts, inflated self-esteem, or impulsive behavior; the change is observable by others but is not severe enough to cause marked impairment or require hospitalization and has no psychotic features.

Hypomanic Episode

Alternate name; see *Hypomania*.

Hypomelanosis Of Ito

A rare condition causing swirled or streaky areas of lighter skin, often from birth. Some affected children also have seizures, developmental differences, eye problems, or abnormalities of the bones or nervous system.

Hypomethylation

An abnormally low amount of methyl marking on DNA or other molecules. It can change which genes are active and may affect chromosome stability, development, inherited disorders, or cancer cells.

Hypomnesia

Reduced ability to remember or recall information, which may occur with aging, neurologic disease, psychiatric conditions, medications, or other causes.

Hyponatraemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Hyponatremia*.

Hyponatremia

An abnormally low level of sodium in the blood, often caused by excess water, fluid loss, medicines, heart or liver disease, kidney problems, or hormone disorders. It may cause nausea, headache, confusion, seizures, or coma; severe or rapidly developing cases are emergencies.

Hypoparathyroidism

A disorder in which too little parathyroid hormone causes low blood calcium and high phosphate. It most often follows neck surgery but can be inherited or autoimmune. Tingling, muscle cramps, spasms, seizures, or abnormal heart rhythms may occur; treatment replaces calcium and active vitamin D.

Hypopharyngeal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the lower part of the throat beside the voice box and esophagus. It may cause persistent sore throat, painful swallowing, difficulty swallowing, ear pain, or a neck lump and may be cancerous.

Hypopharynx

The lower part of the pharynx behind and beside the larynx, extending from the oropharynx to the esophagus. It directs food toward the esophagus during swallowing.

Hypophosphataemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Hypophosphatemia*.

Hypophosphatasia (HPP)

A rare inherited disorder caused by deficient tissue-nonspecific alkaline phosphatase, usually because of *ALPL* variants. Poor bone and tooth mineralization can cause rickets or osteomalacia, fractures, bone pain, premature loss of teeth, or respiratory problems in severe infantile disease.

Hypophosphatemia

An abnormally low concentration of phosphate in the bloodstream. Because phosphate is an essential mineral required by all cells to produce cellular energy and maintain strong bones and teeth, severe deficiency starves muscles and organs of energy. It can lead to muscle weakness, bone pain, breathing difficulty, and confusion, frequently occurring in malnourished individuals upon reintroducing nutrition, severe diabetes crises, or chronic alcohol use.

Alternate Names:
Low Blood Phosphate; Hypophosphataemia; Phosphate Deficiency

Hypophosphatemic Rickets

Rickets caused by low phosphate availability, often from renal phosphate wasting, leading to defective mineralization, bowed legs, bone pain, growth impairment, and dental abnormalities.

Hypophysectomy

Surgical removal of all or part of the pituitary gland, usually performed through the nose and sphenoid sinus (transsphenoidal hypophysectomy) or rarely through an open craniotomy to treat pituitary tumors, relieve optic nerve compression, or control hormone hypersecretion.

Alternate Names:

Pituitary Resection

Hypophysis

An endocrine gland at the base of the brain that regulates growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, and water balance through its hormones.

Alternate Names:
Pituitary Gland; Master Endocrine Gland

Hypophysitis

Inflammation of the pituitary gland that can cause headache, visual symptoms, and deficiency or excess of pituitary hormones; it may be autoimmune, related to pregnancy, or triggered by immune-checkpoint therapy.

Hypopigmentation

Reduced skin pigmentation producing paler areas than the surrounding skin, caused by decreased melanin, reduced melanocyte function or number, inflammation, injury, infection, or inherited disorders.

Hypopituitarism

Deficiency of one or more pituitary hormones due to a disorder of the pituitary gland or hypothalamus, or to surgery, radiation, or injury. Effects depend on the hormones affected and may include problems with growth, thyroid or adrenal function, menstruation, fertility, milk production, or water balance.

Alternate Names:
Pituitary Insufficiency

Hypoplasia

Incomplete or underdevelopment of a tissue, organ, or body structure, resulting in reduced size or functional capacity. It may be congenital, developmental, genetic, or acquired and ranges from a mild anatomical variant to severe organ dysfunction. Assessment considers the timing of onset, associated malformations, tissue function, and whether the process is isolated or syndromic.

Hypoplastic Left Heart Syndrome

A congenital heart defect in which the left ventricle and other left-sided structures, typically including the mitral valve, aortic valve, and ascending aorta, are severely underdeveloped. The left side cannot pump enough blood to support circulation to the body.

Hypoplastic Left Heart Syndrome (HLHS)

Alternate name; see *Hypoplastic Left Heart Syndrome*.

Hypoploidy

A chromosome number below the normal diploid complement, caused by loss of one or more chromosomes; in tumor cytogenetics it may have prognostic significance.

Hypopnea

A period of unusually shallow or reduced breathing, often during sleep. Repeated episodes can lower blood oxygen, disturb sleep, and contribute to obstructive sleep apnea or other breathing disorders.

Hypoproliferative Anemia

Anemia caused by inadequate red-cell production, usually with an inappropriately low reticulocyte response. Causes include iron deficiency, inflammation, kidney disease, endocrine or nutritional disorders, and bone-marrow failure or infiltration.

Hypoproteinaemia

Hypoproteinaemia is an abnormally low level of proteins in the blood, which may result from malnutrition, liver disease, kidney protein loss, or intestinal loss.

Hypoproteinemia

An abnormally low amount of protein in the blood, often involving albumin, which can cause swelling and reflect poor nutrition, liver disease, kidney loss, or illness.

Hypopyon

A visible white or yellow level of inflammatory material in the front chamber of the eye. It usually indicates severe eye inflammation or infection and may occur with pain, redness, light sensitivity, and reduced vision.

Hyporeninemic Hypoaldosteronism

Reduced aldosterone production associated with inappropriately low renin activity, often occurring with diabetic kidney disease or other chronic kidney disorders. Hyperkalemia and a mild normal-anion-gap metabolic acidosis are common findings.

Hyposmia

A reduced ability to smell, without complete loss of smell. It can follow a cold or COVID-19, nasal blockage, head injury, medicines, aging, or a neurologic disorder.

Hypospadias

A birth condition in which the opening of the urethra is on the underside of the penis rather than at its tip. The penis may curve, and the foreskin may be incomplete; severity depends on the opening's location and other abnormalities.

Hypospadias Repair

Surgery reconstructs the urethral opening and, when needed, straightens the penis in a child born with hypospadias; timing and technique depend on anatomy and surgeon assessment.

Hypotension

Abnormally low blood pressure that may reduce blood flow to the brain and other organs. It can result from bleeding, dehydration, heart problems, severe infection, allergy, or medicines and may cause dizziness, fainting, confusion, or shock.

Hypotension In Anesthesia

Low blood pressure during or soon after anesthesia. It may result from anesthetic medicines, blood loss, dehydration, heart problems, or an allergic reaction; the anesthesia team monitors and treats it according to the cause and severity.

Hypotensive

Describing a state of abnormally low blood pressure or an agent that lowers blood pressure; see also *Hypotension*.

Hypothalamic Amenorrhea

Absence of menstrual periods because the hypothalamus reduces its normal release of reproductive signals. It is often linked to low energy availability, excessive exercise, stress, illness, or weight loss and may cause infertility and bone loss.

Hypothalamic Dysfunction

A problem affecting the brain region that helps control hormones, temperature, appetite, thirst, sleep, stress, and reproduction. Causes include injury, tumors, inflammation, infection, surgery, radiation, or inherited disease.

Hypothalamic Hamartoma

A congenital, noncancerous mass of disorganized hypothalamic tissue that can cause gelastic seizures, precocious puberty, behavioral symptoms, or cognitive decline.

Hypothalamic Hormone

A releasing or inhibiting hormone produced by the hypothalamus that regulates pituitary secretion, including signals controlling thyroid, adrenal, reproductive, growth, and lactation axes.

Hypothalamic Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in or near the hypothalamus, a brain region controlling hormones, temperature, appetite, sleep, and water balance. Effects may include vision changes, hormone problems, headaches, seizures, or altered growth.

Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis

The hormone system linking the brain's hypothalamus and pituitary gland with the adrenal glands. It controls cortisol release, helping regulate the body's response to stress, illness, blood pressure, metabolism, and immune activity.

Alternate Names:

HPA Axis; Neuroendocrine Stress Axis

Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Adrenal Axis Physiology

The brain signals the pituitary gland, which signals the adrenal glands to release cortisol. Cortisol normally follows a daily pattern and feeds back to reduce further signals when enough is present.

Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Gonadal Axis Physiology

The hormone system linking the hypothalamus, pituitary gland, and ovaries or testes. Signals from the hypothalamus prompt the pituitary to release hormones that control ovulation and menstrual cycles, or testosterone production and sperm development.

Hypothalamic-Pituitary-Thyroid Axis Physiology

The hormone system linking the hypothalamus, pituitary gland, and thyroid. The hypothalamus signals the pituitary to release thyroid-stimulating hormone, which prompts the thyroid to make hormones that regulate metabolism, temperature, and energy use.

Hypothalamic Tumor

Alternate name; see *Hypothalamic Neoplasm*.

Hypothalamus

A small region at the base of the brain that helps control automatic body functions and hormone release through the pituitary gland. It regulates body temperature, hunger, thirst, sleep, stress, and parts of emotional behavior.

Hypothermia

A dangerously low internal body temperature, usually below 35 degrees Celsius, caused by cold exposure or impaired heat production. It may cause shivering, confusion, drowsiness, slow breathing, or an abnormal heart rhythm. Severe cases are treated with active rewarming and supportive care.

Alternate Names:
Accidental Hypothermia; Low Core Body Temperature

Hypothermia In Anesthesia

An abnormally low body temperature during or after anesthesia. Anesthetic medicines reduce the body's ability to control heat and may allow heat loss during surgery; warming devices and temperature monitoring help prevent complications.

Hypothyroidism

A condition in which the thyroid gland does not make enough thyroid hormone. This slows many body functions and may cause tiredness, feeling cold, weight gain, constipation, dry skin, or a slow heartbeat. The most common cause is Hashimoto disease, in which the immune system attacks the thyroid. Other causes include thyroid inflammation, surgery or radiation treatment, some medicines, and, less often, problems with the pituitary gland or hypothalamus.

Alternate Names:
Underactive Thyroid; Hypothyroid State; Thyroid Hormone Deficiency

Hypotonia

Decreased muscle tone presenting as a floppy or poorly supported posture. It may result from muscle, peripheral nerve, neuromuscular-junction, spinal-cord, brain, genetic, or metabolic disorders and requires evaluation when persistent or associated with weakness or developmental delay.

Hypotonia-Hypomentia-Hypogonadism-Obesity Syndrome (HHHO)

Historical descriptive name for Prader–Willi syndrome, a genetic disorder involving infantile hypotonia, developmental or intellectual disability, hypogonadism, and later hyperphagia with obesity; see *Prader-Willi Syndrome*.

Hypotonic Solution

A liquid containing fewer dissolved particles than the fluid inside cells. Water tends to move into cells when they are exposed to it, so medical use requires careful selection and monitoring.

Hypotony Maculopathy

A vision-threatening complication of persistent low

intraocular pressure characterized by chorioretinal wrinkling and macular folds, optic disc edema, and decreased visual acuity.

Hypotrichosis

Abnormally sparse or absent hair caused by inherited follicle disorders, autoimmune disease, endocrine or nutritional problems, medications, or scarring alopecia.

Hypotrophy

Underdevelopment or reduced size of a tissue or organ that is present but smaller or less developed than usual. It may begin before birth or result from poor nutrition, reduced use, impaired blood flow, or disease and may affect function.

Hypotropia

Vertical eye misalignment in which one eye deviates downward relative to the other, potentially causing diplopia, abnormal head posture, or suppression of vision.

Hypoventilation

Breathing too slowly or shallowly to remove enough carbon dioxide. It can lower oxygen levels and cause sleepiness, headache, confusion, or respiratory failure; causes include medicines, lung disease, obesity, and muscle or nerve disorders.

Hypoventilation Syndromes

Disorders in which alveolar ventilation is inadequate, causing elevated carbon dioxide, often with low oxygen. Causes include obesity hypoventilation, neuromuscular weakness, chest-wall disease, medicines, and impaired respiratory control; evaluation includes sleep and blood-gas assessment.

Hypovolaemia

Hypovolaemia is an abnormally low volume of circulating blood or body fluid, commonly caused by bleeding, dehydration, or major fluid loss.

Hypovolemia

Hypovolemia is reduced effective circulating blood volume, usually from bleeding, fluid loss, or inadequate intake; it can cause tachycardia, hypotension, poor perfusion, kidney injury, and hypovolaemic shock.

Hypovolemic Shock

Circulatory failure from loss of intravascular volume, reducing venous return, cardiac output, and tissue perfusion. Hemorrhage is the most dangerous cause; other causes include vomiting, diarrhea, burns, third-spacing, and severe dehydration. Tachycardia, narrow pulse pressure, cool clammy skin, delayed capillary refill, oliguria, confusion, and elevated lactate may occur.

Hypoxaemia

An abnormally low oxygen level in arterial blood. It can result from lung disease, breathing problems, poor blood flow, or other conditions and may cause shortness of breath, confusion, bluish skin, or organ injury.

Hypoxanthine

A naturally occurring substance made when the body breaks down certain genetic-material building blocks. It is normally reused or changed into other compounds during purine metabolism.

Hypoxemia

An abnormally low oxygen level in arterial blood. It can lead to hypoxia, which means too little oxygen in body tissues. Anemia or poor blood flow can cause hypoxia without hypoxemia.

Hypoxia

Inadequate oxygen availability at the tissue level. It may result from low arterial oxygen, anemia, reduced blood flow, or impaired cellular oxygen use.

Hypoxia And Hypoxemia

Hypoxemia is low oxygen in arterial blood, while hypoxia is inadequate oxygen at the tissue level. Causes include lung disease, airway obstruction, heart disease, anemia, shock, or high altitude; severe breathlessness, cyanosis, confusion, or collapse is urgent.

Hypoxia-Inducible Factor

A family of transcription factors that helps cells adapt to low oxygen. Each complex generally combines an oxygen-regulated alpha subunit (HIF-1 alpha, HIF-2 alpha, or HIF-3 alpha) with a constitutively expressed beta subunit. These factors activate genes involved in oxygen delivery, metabolism, and cell survival; HIF-1 is one member of the family.

Alternate Names:
HIF

Hypoxic Cell Injury

Damage to cells caused by too little oxygen. It may result from poor blood flow, low blood oxygen, anemia, or poisoning that prevents oxygen use; the outcome depends on how severe and prolonged the oxygen shortage is.

Hypoxic-Ischemic Brain Injury

Brain damage caused by too little oxygen and blood flow. It may follow cardiac arrest, suffocation, shock, or severe breathing failure and can cause seizures, coma, memory problems, movement problems, or disability.

Hypoxic Ischemic Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction caused by insufficient oxygen and blood flow, usually around birth in newborns but also after cardiac arrest or severe respiratory failure. It can cause seizures, altered consciousness, and long-term neurologic disability.

Hypoxic Pulmonary Vasoconstriction

Narrowing of small blood vessels in an area of the lung that receives too little oxygen. This normally redirects blood toward better-ventilated lung areas, but widespread or prolonged narrowing can strain the heart.

Hypsarrhythmia

A very abnormal, disorganized pattern on an electroencephalogram, with large slow waves and spikes arising from many areas of the brain. It is strongly associated with infantile spasms, a serious seizure disorder in babies; treatment is directed at controlling the spasms and underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Hypsarrhythmic EEG Pattern; Chaotic Dysrhythmic EEG

Hysterectomy

Surgical removal of the uterus. The cervix, fallopian tubes, and ovaries may or may not also be removed, depending on the procedure and clinical indication. Hysterectomy permanently ends menstruation and the ability to carry a pregnancy, but it does not cause immediate menopause when functioning ovaries remain. If the cervix remains, cervical cancer screening may still be needed. Indications include cancer, fibroids, severe bleeding, adenomyosis, endometriosis, chronic pelvic pain, and uterine prolapse.

Hysterectomy And Surgical Menopause

Hysterectomy removes the uterus and ends menstruation and the ability to carry a pregnancy. Surgical menopause occurs when both ovaries are removed or ovarian function otherwise stops abruptly; hysterectomy alone does not necessarily cause menopause if the ovaries remain.

Hysteria

An outdated term historically applied to a wide range of physical, emotional, and behavioral symptoms. It does not name one specific current diagnosis; some conditions once grouped under this label are now diagnosed as functional neurologic disorder or other disorders.

Hysterosalpingo-Contrast Sonography

An ultrasound test using fluid or foam contrast to assess the uterine cavity and whether the fallopian tubes are open. It is often used during fertility evaluation without X-ray radiation.

Alternate Names:
HyCoSy; Fallopian Tubal Contrast Ultrasound

Hysterosalpingo-Contrast-Sonography

Alternate spelling; see *Hysterosalpingo-Contrast Sonography*.

Hysterosalpingogram

An X-ray procedure used to evaluate the uterine cavity and fallopian tube patency. A radiopaque contrast medium is injected through the cervix, and serial X-ray images are taken as the contrast fills the uterine cavity and spills from the fallopian tubes.

Hysterosalpingography

An X-ray test in which contrast liquid is placed through the cervix to outline the inside of the uterus and fallopian tubes. It can show blockage, an unusual uterine shape, fibroids, polyps, or scar tissue during infertility evaluation. Cramping, bleeding, infection, or contrast reaction can occur.

Hysteroscope

A thin camera-equipped instrument passed through the cervix to inspect the uterine cavity and, when designed for operative use, remove polyps, treat bleeding, or perform other procedures.

Hysteroscopic Metroplasty

A procedure that uses a small camera and instruments passed through the cervix to divide a wall of tissue separating part of the uterus. It may improve the uterine cavity in selected people with fertility problems or repeated pregnancy loss.

Hysteroscopic Myomectomy

A procedure that removes selected fibroids bulging into the inside of the uterus. A camera and instruments pass through the cervix, avoiding an abdominal incision; the procedure may reduce heavy bleeding and improve fertility.

Hysteroscopy

A procedure in which a thin camera tube is passed through the vagina and cervix into the uterus to view its lining. Fluid opens the uterine cavity for a clearer view. The procedure can help find causes of abnormal bleeding and may allow a tissue sample or removal of polyps, selected fibroids, or scar tissue.

Hysterotomy

A surgical incision into the uterus performed during selected obstetric or gynecologic procedures. It may be used to deliver a baby or reach the uterus, with risks including bleeding and infection.

I

Iatrogenic

Describing an illness, injury, or other harm caused unintentionally by medical examination, treatment, a medicine, a procedure, or a healthcare device. Examples include side effects, procedure-related bleeding, infection, nerve damage, or radiation injury. The term does not imply negligence.

Iatrogenic Cushing Syndrome

Cortisol excess caused by prescribed or nonprescribed glucocorticoid exposure, including systemic, injected, inhaled, topical, or potent local preparations. Features may include weight gain, hypertension, diabetes, bruising, muscle weakness, infection risk, and adrenal suppression.

Iatrogenic Disease

Illness or injury caused unintentionally by a medical examination, treatment, medicine, procedure, or healthcare device. It may be temporary or permanent and does not by itself imply negligence.

Iatrogenic Injury

Harm caused unintentionally by a medical examination, treatment, procedure, medicine, or healthcare device. It may be temporary or permanent and can include infection, bleeding, medication effects, nerve damage, or injury during surgery.

Iatrogenic Pneumothorax

A pneumothorax caused by medical care, such as insertion of a central venous catheter, lung biopsy, or thoracentesis. Positive-pressure ventilation can also cause pneumothorax through lung barotrauma.

Ibandronic Acid

A bisphosphonate medicine used in some settings to reduce bone loss and complications from cancer affecting bone. It can rarely damage the jaw or cause unusual thigh fractures.

IBD

Abbreviation; see *Inflammatory Bowel Disease*.

Alternate Names:
Inflammatory bowel disease

Ibritumomab Tiuxetan

An antibody linked to a radioactive substance and used in selected B-cell lymphomas. The antibody attaches to CD20-positive cells and delivers radiation; low blood counts, infection, and delayed marrow problems are important risks.

IBS

Abbreviation; see *Irritable Bowel Syndrome*.

IBS-D

The diarrhea-predominant form of irritable bowel syndrome, with recurrent abdominal pain and loose or frequent stools. It is a disorder of gut–brain interaction and does not cause visible damage to the digestive tract.

Alternate Names:
Diarrhea-Predominant Irritable Bowel Syndrome

IBS (Irritable Bowel Syndrome)

Alternate name; see *Irritable Bowel Syndrome*.

Ibuprofen

A medicine that reduces pain, fever, and inflammation. It can irritate or bleed the stomach, harm the kidneys, cause fluid retention, or increase heart risks in some people.

Ibuprofen Overdose

Toxic exposure to more ibuprofen than recommended, which can cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, metabolic acidosis, drowsiness, seizures, or coma.

Ibuprofen Toxicity

Alternate term; see *Ibuprofen Overdose*.

IC

Abbreviation for interstitial cystitis, also called bladder pain syndrome; see *Interstitial Cystitis*.

ICD

Abbreviation that may mean implantable cardioverter-defibrillator, a device that detects and treats dangerous heart rhythms, or International Classification of Diseases, a system for coding health conditions. Context determines the meaning.

Alternate Names:
Implantable cardioverter defibrillator

ICD-10

The tenth revision of the World Health Organization's International Classification of Diseases, used to code diseases, injuries, and causes of death. National versions may add detail for clinical records and billing.

ICD-11

The World Health Organization's 11th revision of the International Classification of Diseases. It took effect on January 1, 2022, but countries adopt and implement it on different schedules. It is designed for recording, reporting, and analyzing diseases, injuries, and causes of death.

ICD-O Neoplasm Morphology

Classification

A coding system used by cancer registries and pathology services to record what type of tumor is present and whether it is benign or cancerous. It does not replace the diagnosis, location, or stage of the cancer.

ICD Shock Therapy

Treatment delivered by an implanted defibrillator to stop dangerous heart rhythms. The device may use painless pacing or an electrical shock, depending on the rhythm.

Iceland Disease

Historical name for epidemic neuromyasthenia, now generally classified among outbreaks of myalgic encephalomyelitis/chronic fatigue syndrome.

Icelandic Type Amyloidosis (Type VI)

Hereditary cerebral amyloid angiopathy caused by cystatin C amyloid deposition in cerebral blood vessels; it can cause recurrent brain hemorrhage and neurologic disability.

I-Cell Disease

Older name; see *Mucolipidosis II Alpha/Beta*.

Ice Pack

A device that applies cold to a body area to help relieve pain or swelling. Direct or prolonged contact can injure the skin.

Ice Pick Headache

A sudden, severe, stabbing head pain that usually lasts seconds. Attacks may recur in different head areas without warning; new, persistent, or unusually severe pain can have other causes.

Alternate Names:
Primary stabbing headache

ICF Framework

A World Health Organization framework for describing how a health condition affects body functions, daily activities, participation in life, and the person's environment. It supports a broader view of

disability than diagnosis alone.

Ichthyosis

A group of disorders of skin keratinization characterized by persistently dry, thickened, scaling skin. Forms may be inherited, with onset at birth or later, or acquired in association with systemic disease or medicines.

Ichthyosis Vulgaris

A common inherited skin condition causing dry, fine scaling, especially on the arms and legs. It often improves with age and can be managed with regular moisturizers and prescribed scale-reducing treatments.

Ictal State

The period during which an epileptic seizure is occurring, between the pre-seizure and recovery periods.

Icteric

Describing yellowing of the skin, whites of the eyes, or other tissues caused by too much bilirubin in the blood.

Icteric Index

The icteric index is a laboratory estimate of serum yellow discoloration related mainly to bilirubin and can signal jaundice or interfere with testing.

Icterus

Yellowing of the skin or whites of the eyes caused by excess bilirubin. It may result from liver disease, blocked bile flow, or rapid breakdown of red blood cells.

Icterus (Chronic Familial)

Alternate name for Gilbert syndrome, an inherited disorder causing intermittent mild unconjugated hyperbilirubinemia; see *Gilbert Syndrome*.

Ictus

A sudden neurologic event, usually a stroke or seizure. The word does not identify the specific illness or its cause.

ICU-Acquired Weakness

Generalized muscle weakness that develops during critical illness or an intensive-care stay. It may result from critical illness myopathy, critical illness polyneuropathy, or both and can delay movement and removal from a ventilator.

Idarubicin

An anthracycline chemotherapy medicine that damages cancer-cell DNA by inhibiting topoisomerase II. It is used mainly for acute myeloid leukemia; low blood counts and heart damage are important risks.

IDC

Abbreviation; see *Invasive Carcinoma Of No Special Type*.

Idea Of Reference

Singular form; see *Ideas Of Reference*.

Ideas Of Reference

The belief that ordinary events, comments, media messages, or other people's actions have a special personal meaning. When held with strong conviction despite contrary evidence, it may occur in psychotic or mood disorders.

Ideation

The formation or content of thoughts, especially thoughts related to a particular behavior or symptom. Clinical examples include suicidal ideation and homicidal ideation, for which intent, plan, means, and immediate safety are relevant features.

Identical Twins

Two individuals formed when one fertilized egg separates into two embryos. They usually have nearly identical DNA, but differences can develop through mutations, epigenetic changes, environment, and chance.

Idiopathic

Describing a condition for which no specific cause has been identified after appropriate evaluation. It does not mean that the condition is imaginary, unim-

portant, or untreatable; it means that its cause is currently unknown.

Idiopathic Amyloidosis

Amyloidosis without an identified underlying cause after appropriate evaluation; the clinical manifestations depend on the organs involved and the amyloid protein.

Idiopathic Anaphylaxis

Anaphylaxis for which no trigger is identified after a detailed history and appropriate evaluation; it is a diagnosis of exclusion. Some cases may reflect an overlooked allergen, medication, cofactor, or an underlying mast-cell disorder. The clinical features are the same as in anaphylaxis with an identified trigger.

Idiopathic Aplastic Anemia

Aplastic anemia in which no specific cause is identified after evaluation; see *Aplastic Anemia*.

Idiopathic Autoimmune Hemolytic Anemia

Autoimmune hemolytic anemia without an identified associated disease, medicine, or other trigger; see *Autoimmune Hemolytic Anemia*.

Idiopathic Basal Ganglia Calcification

Calcification of the basal ganglia without an identified secondary cause, historically called Fahr disease; symptoms may include movement, psychiatric, cognitive, or seizure disorders.

Idiopathic Chronic Erosive Gastritis

Long-standing erosive inflammation of the stomach lining without an identified cause; see *Erosive Gastritis*.

Idiopathic Dilated Cardiomyopathy

Dilated cardiomyopathy without an identified cause after evaluation; see *Dilated Cardiomyopathy*.

Idiopathic Edema

Persistent swelling, usually of the legs, occurring without an identified heart, kidney, liver, venous, lymphatic, or medication-related cause. The diagnosis is one of exclusion after common causes are evaluated.

Idiopathic Facial Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Bell's Palsy*.

Idiopathic Granulomatous Mastitis

A rare benign inflammatory breast disease in which granulomas form around breast lobules and no specific cause is identified after evaluation. It can cause a painful breast mass, redness, abscesses, or draining sinuses and can resemble breast cancer. The diagnosis requires excluding infections and other causes of granulomatous inflammation.

Idiopathic Guttate Hypomelanosis

Harmless, small, flat white spots caused by reduced skin pigment, usually on the shins or forearms of older adults. They are not contagious and generally cause no symptoms.

Idiopathic Hypercalciuria

Excess calcium in the urine without an identified cause. It can increase the risk of kidney stones and, less often, bone loss.

Idiopathic Hypersomnia

A sleep disorder that causes extreme daytime sleepiness, long or unrefreshing sleep, and difficulty waking up, even when a person has enough time to sleep. Diagnosis follows exclusion of other causes of excessive sleepiness.

Idiopathic Interstitial Pneumonias

A group of interstitial lung diseases with no identified cause, characterized by varying degrees of lung inflammation and fibrosis; diagnosis requires clinical, radiologic, and sometimes pathologic assessment.

Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension

A disorder of elevated cerebrospinal-fluid pressure without an identified cause. It can cause headache, pulsatile tinnitus, and papilledema (optic-nerve

swelling), which can impair vision or lead to permanent vision loss.

Idiopathic Myelofibrosis

Alternate name; see *Primary Myelofibrosis*.

Idiopathic Normal-Pressure Hydrocephalus

A condition, usually affecting older adults, in which the brain's fluid-filled ventricles enlarge without a known cause. It often causes a slow, unsteady walk, slowed thinking, or urinary urgency or loss of bladder control. The pressure of the fluid around the brain and spinal cord is typically within the normal range when measured, although it can fluctuate.

Idiopathic Pulmonary Arterial Hypertension

Group 1 pulmonary arterial hypertension in which no associated disease, drug or toxin, heritable cause, or other explanation is found after appropriate evaluation. It increases resistance in the pulmonary arteries and strains the right ventricle, causing exertional breathlessness, fatigue, chest discomfort, dizziness, fainting, or swelling. Diagnosis is confirmed with right-heart catheterization and specialist assessment.

Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis

A chronic, progressive lung disease in which the tissue deep inside the lungs becomes thick, stiff, and scarred over time without a known cause. As scarring worsens, the lungs lose their elasticity and cannot effectively transfer oxygen into the bloodstream. It most commonly affects older adults, causing a dry, persistent cough and worsening shortness of breath during daily physical activities.

Alternate Names:
IPF; Cryptogenic Fibrosing Alveolitis

Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura

Older name; see *Immune Thrombocytopenia*.

Idiopathic Toe Walking

Persistent walking on the toes without an identified neurologic, muscular, or structural cause. It usually begins in childhood and may occur on one or both sides; continued toe walking can shorten the calf muscles or Achilles tendons.

Idiosyncrasy

An unusual individual reaction to a medicine or exposure that is not explained by the usual pharmacologic effect.

Idiosyncratic Reaction

An unusual adverse response to a medicine that is not predictable from its usual pharmacologic effects and may occur at ordinary doses. Some idiosyncratic reactions are linked to genetic factors.

Idioventricular Rhythm

A slow heart rhythm that starts in the lower chambers of the heart instead of the normal pacemaker. It may occur when the usual electrical signal is blocked or when the heart is severely ill.

Id Reaction (Autoeczematization)

A secondary, usually itchy eczematous rash that appears at sites distant from an infection or inflammatory skin disorder, often on the hands, feet, or trunk.

Ifosfamide

Ifosfamide is an alkylating chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used for selected sarcomas and other cancers; adverse effects include haemorrhagic cystitis, encephalopathy, infertility, and myelosuppression. Mesna and monitoring are used to reduce selected toxicities.

iFR

Alternate name; see *Instantaneous Wave-Free Ratio*.

Ig

Abbreviation for immunoglobulin, an antibody protein produced by B cells and plasma cells; major classes include IgG, IgA, IgM, IgE, and IgD.

IgA

Abbreviation; see *Immunoglobulin A*.

IgA Nephropathy

A kidney disease caused by deposits of immunoglobulin A in the kidney filters, potentially leading to blood in urine, protein loss, high blood pressure, or kidney failure.

Alternate Names:
Berger's Disease

IgA Pemphigus

A rare autoimmune blistering disorder in which IgA antibodies target epidermal cell-adhesion proteins. It causes superficial pustules or blisters, often in annular or circinate patterns, and diagnosis relies on biopsy and direct immunofluorescence.

IgA Vasculitis

A small-vessel vasculitis associated with IgA immune deposits, also called Henoch-Schönlein purpura. It most often affects children and classically causes palpable purpura, joint pain, abdominal symptoms, and sometimes kidney inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Henoch-Schonlein Purpura

IgD

Abbreviation; see *Immunoglobulin D*.

IgE

Abbreviation; see *Immunoglobulin E*.

IgG

Abbreviation; see *Immunoglobulin G*.

IgG4-Related Disease

An uncommon immune disorder that causes inflammation and scar-like growths in one or more organs. It may affect the pancreas, salivary glands, eyes, kidneys, lungs, or blood vessels; diagnosis usually requires imaging, blood tests, and sometimes a biopsy.

IgG4-Related Disease Arteritis

Inflammation of a large or medium-sized artery as part of IgG4-related disease. It may thicken or weaken the artery and can cause narrowing, an aneurysm, pain, or reduced blood flow.

IgG4-Related Ophthalmic Disease

An immune disorder that causes inflammation and firm swelling around the eye, including the tear glands, eyelids, or eye muscles. It may cause bulging, eyelid swelling, double vision, or reduced vision and may affect other organs.

IgG and Complement Deposition

A skin-biopsy finding on direct immunofluorescence in which immunoglobulin G (IgG) and complement proteins, often C3, collect along the junction between the outer skin layer and the tissue beneath it. Linear deposits can occur in pemphigoid diseases, while granular deposits can occur in lupus; the pattern helps distinguish these conditions but does not establish a diagnosis by itself.

IgM

Abbreviation; see *Immunoglobulin M*.

IGRT

Image-guided radiation therapy uses medical imaging, such as CT, MRI, ultrasound, or X-ray, to position the patient and target radiation accurately before or during treatment. It helps deliver radiation to a tumor while reducing exposure to nearby healthy tissue.

IIH

Abbreviation; see *Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension*.

Ileal Atresia

A condition present at birth in which part of the ileum, the last section of the small intestine, is closed or missing. It causes bowel blockage in a newborn, with a swollen abdomen, green vomiting, and failure to pass the first stool.

Ileal Conduit

A surgically created urine passage made from a short piece of the ileum, the last part of the small intestine. It carries urine from the ureters to an

opening in the abdominal wall and an external bag.

Ileal Fistula

An abnormal connection involving the ileum and another organ, bowel segment, or skin surface, which may cause intestinal contents to leak and lead to infection, malnutrition, or fluid loss.

Ileal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the ileum, the distal portion of the small intestine, caused by ulceration, inflammation, vascular lesions, tumors, trauma, or other disease.

Ileal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the ileum, the last part of the small intestine. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause pain, bleeding, blockage, anemia, or no symptoms.

Ileal Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of the ileum, the final part of the small intestine. Adhesions, hernias, inflammatory bowel disease, tumors, or twisting may cause cramping pain, vomiting, swelling, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Ileal Pouch-Anal Anastomosis

An operation that removes the colon and rectum and creates a pouch from the end of the small intestine. The pouch is connected to the anus so bowel movements can continue through the usual route.

Ileal Stenosis

Narrowing of the ileum that may impair passage of intestinal contents and result from Crohn disease, inflammation, scarring, ischemia, tumor, or surgery.

Ileal Ulcer

An ileal ulcer is a break in the lining of the ileum caused by inflammation, infection, medicines, ischemia, trauma, or another intestinal disorder.

Ileitis

Inflammation of the ileum, the last part of the small intestine. Causes include Crohn disease, infection, reduced blood flow, medicines, and other disorders; symptoms may include lower-right abdominal pain, diarrhea, fever, or bleeding.

Ileocaecal

Relating to the junction between the ileum, the last part of the small intestine, and the cecum, the first part of the large intestine.

Ileocecal Junction

The point where the ileum, the last part of the small intestine, joins the cecum, the first part of the large intestine.

Ileocecal Valve

A flap-like structure where the last part of the small intestine joins the first part of the large intestine. It helps control passage of intestinal contents and limits backflow from the colon.

Ileostomy

An operation that brings the end of the small intestine through an opening in the abdomen so stool drains into an external pouch. Output is often liquid and can cause fluid and salt loss or skin irritation.

Ileum

The final and longest part of the small intestine. It absorbs vitamin B12, bile salts, and remaining nutrients before food passes into the large intestine.

Ileus

A temporary slowdown or stop in the normal movement of the intestines, without a physical blockage. It can cause a swollen belly, nausea, vomiting, and difficulty passing stool or gas. It often follows surgery or occurs with illness or certain medicines.

Iliac

Relating to the ilium or the iliac region, including the iliac bones and iliac blood vessels.

Iliac Artery

One of the large arteries that carries blood to the pelvis and lower limb. The common iliac arteries

divide into internal branches for the pelvic organs and external branches that continue into the legs.

Iliac Crest

The iliac crest is the curved upper border of the ilium and a landmark and attachment site for abdominal, back, and pelvic muscles.

Iliac Crest Bone Graft

The surgical harvesting of cancellous and cortical bone from the anterior or posterior iliac crest of the pelvis to provide an osteoconductive, osteoinductive, and osteogenic autologous graft for orthopaedic nonunion fracture repair or spinal fusion.

Alternate Names:
ICBG

Iliac Vein

An iliac vein drains blood from the pelvis and lower limb toward the inferior vena cava; thrombosis can cause swelling and pulmonary embolism.

Iliopsoas Muscles

The psoas major and iliacus muscles working together to bend the hip. They help lift the thigh, stabilize the spine, and maintain posture, and may cause groin or back pain when strained.

Alternate Names:
Iliopsoas

Iliopsoas Tendinitis

Overuse-related irritation of the iliopsoas tendon, causing pain in the groin or front of the hip that may worsen with hip flexion, running, or rising from a chair.

Iliopsoas Bursitis

Inflammation of the fluid-filled sac between the iliopsoas muscle and the front of the hip joint. It can cause pain in the groin or front of the hip, especially when straightening or bending the hip.

Iliotibial Band

A strong band of tissue running along the outer side of the thigh from the hip to the knee. It helps stabilize the hip and knee during movement.

Iliotibial Band Friction Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Iliotibial Band Syndrome*.

Iliotibial Band Syndrome

Pain on the outer side of the knee caused by irritation of the iliotibial band, especially during repeated activities such as running or cycling.

Alternate Names:
ITBS; IT Band Friction Syndrome

Ilium

The broad, upper part of each hip bone. It joins the sacrum at the back, helps form the hip socket, and provides attachment for muscles of the abdomen, back, pelvis, and thigh. Its upper edge is the iliac crest.

Illinois Type Amyloidosis

Historical or imprecise label for primary, usually immunoglobulin light-chain amyloidosis; the label alone does not establish the type of deposited protein.

Illness Anxiety Disorder

Persistent fear of having or developing a serious illness despite few or no physical symptoms. The person may repeatedly check the body, seek reassurance, search for health information, or avoid medical care; symptoms last at least six months.

Illusion

A misperception or misinterpretation of a real external stimulus, such as mistaking a shadow for a person. Illusions may occur with visual impairment, delirium, seizures, intoxication, or severe psychiatric illness and differ from hallucinations, which occur without an external stimulus.

Iloprost

A prostacyclin analogue that causes vasodilation and inhibits platelet aggregation; inhaled or infused formulations are used for selected forms of pulmonary hypertension and severe peripheral is-

chemia.

Image-Guided Ablation

Destruction of selected abnormal tissue with heat, cold, electricity, or chemicals while ultrasound, CT, MRI, or another imaging method guides and monitors the treatment. It may treat tumors, abnormal heart rhythms, or other disease.

Image-Guided Biopsy

Removal of a tissue sample while ultrasound, CT, MRI, mammography, or fluoroscopy guides the needle or instrument to the target and helps avoid critical structures.

Image-Guided Drainage

Placement of a needle or catheter while imaging guides its path to remove pus, blood, bile, urine, or other trapped fluid. It may treat an abscess, infected collection, or symptomatic cyst and can cause bleeding or infection.

Image-Guided Therapy

A procedure in which ultrasound, CT, X-ray, MRI, or another imaging method guides a needle, catheter, or treatment device to a specific area. This can improve accuracy while limiting injury to nearby tissue.

Imaging

The production of pictures of internal body structures using methods such as radiography, ultrasound, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, or nuclear medicine.

Imaging And Radiology

Imaging and radiology use methods such as X-ray, ultrasound, CT, and MRI to create pictures that help diagnose or guide treatment of disease.

Imaging-Guided Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Image-Guided Biopsy*.

Imaging Technique

An imaging technique is a method for producing pictures of body structures or processes, such as ultrasound, CT, MRI, or nuclear imaging.

Imatinib Mesylate

The mesylate salt of imatinib, a tyrosine-kinase inhibitor used to treat BCR-ABL-positive chronic myeloid leukemia, gastrointestinal stromal tumors with KIT alterations, and other selected cancers.

Imerslund-GräSbeck Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which the small intestine cannot absorb vitamin B12 properly. It can cause low B12 levels, anemia, tiredness, numbness, balance problems, or other nerve damage despite adequate dietary intake.

Imidazoles

A group of antifungal medicines, including clotrimazole, miconazole, and ketoconazole, used to treat fungal infections of the skin, mouth, or other body areas.

Iminoacetic Acid Scan

A nuclear medicine scan using a radioactive iminodiacetic acid tracer to show how bile moves through the liver, gallbladder, and bile ducts.

Alternate Names:
HIDA Scan; Hepatobiliary Iminodiacetic Acid Scan

Imipenem

A strong antibiotic, usually given with cilastatin, used for serious bacterial infections. It can cause allergic reactions, stomach problems, seizures, or antibiotic resistance.

Imipramine

A medicine used for depression and some bladder problems. It can cause dry mouth, constipation, dizziness, abnormal heart rhythms, and dangerous effects in overdose.

Imipramine Overdose

Toxic ingestion of imipramine, a tricyclic antidepressant, which can cause anticholinergic effects, seizures, hypotension, ventricular arrhythmias,

coma, and life-threatening cardiac toxicity.

Imiquimod

Imiquimod is a topical immune-response modifier that activates Toll-like receptor 7 and induces cytokines; it treats selected actinic keratoses, superficial basal-cell carcinomas, and external genital warts, often causing local inflammation.

Immature Ovarian Teratoma

A rare cancer of the ovary made from immature cells that can develop into different body tissues. It occurs most often in teenagers or young adults, and its grade and spread guide treatment.

Immediate Hypersensitivity

A rapid allergic reaction, usually involving IgE antibodies and mast cells. It can cause hives, itching, swelling, wheezing, vomiting, or anaphylaxis within minutes of exposure.

Immersion Foot

A painful cold injury caused by prolonged exposure of the feet to cold, wet conditions without freezing, leading to numbness, swelling, and skin changes.

Alternate Names:
Trench Foot

Immobilization

Restriction of movement of a body part or the whole patient, using rest, splints, casts, braces, traction, or other methods. It may protect an injury but can cause stiffness, pressure injury, muscle loss, venous thromboembolism, and other complications if prolonged.

Immobilize

To restrict movement of a body part, often with a splint or cast, to support healing.

Alternate Names:
Immobilization

Immotile Cilia Syndrome

A genetically heterogeneous autosomal recessive ciliopathy caused by structural defects in ciliary axonemal dynein arms, leading to impaired mucociliary clearance, recurrent sinopulmonary infections, bronchiectasis, male infertility, and situs inversus in the subgroup known as Kartagener syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Primary Ciliary Dyskinesia; PCD

Immune

Having an immune response that recognizes and helps protect against a particular antigen, infection, or toxin; immunity may be innate or acquired.

Immune And Infectious Diseases

Conditions involving abnormal immune defenses or infections caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites. Examples include autoimmune disease, allergy, weakened immunity, and infections that are unusually severe or recurrent.

Immune Checkpoint

A control signal that helps prevent immune cells from becoming too active or damaging healthy tissue. Some cancer medicines block these signals to help immune cells attack tumors, but this can cause inflammation in normal organs.

Immune Checkpoint Inhibitor

A cancer medicine that blocks an immune-checkpoint signal, helping immune cells recognize and attack cancer cells. It can also cause inflammation in normal organs, called an immune-related adverse event.

Immune Complex

A cluster formed when an antibody attaches to a foreign or abnormal substance. If these clusters are not cleared, they can collect in tissues and cause inflammation, blood-vessel damage, or kidney disease.

Immune Disorder

A condition caused by an immune system that is overactive, underactive, misdirected, or otherwise abnormal. Major groups include autoimmune disease, immunodeficiency, allergy and hypersensitivity, immune dysregulation, and some inflammatory dis-

orders.

Immune Evasion

The ability of an infection, tumor, or abnormal cell to avoid being recognized or destroyed by the immune system. It may hide identifying markers, block immune signals, or resist immune-cell attack.

Immune Hemolytic Anemia

Anemia caused when antibodies or other immune proteins destroy red blood cells too quickly. It may cause tiredness, jaundice, dark urine, rapid heartbeat, breathlessness, or an enlarged spleen and may follow illness, medicines, or transfusion.

Immune Interference

In vaccinology, an interaction in which one vaccine, antigen, or pre-existing immune response changes the size or type of the immune response to another vaccine antigen. The response may be reduced or increased, and a measured change does not necessarily mean that protection from disease is reduced.

Immune-Mediated Necrotizing Myopathy

An uncommon autoimmune muscle disease that causes worsening weakness, especially in the hips and shoulders, and often markedly raises muscle enzymes. Some cases are linked to statins or specific antibodies; diagnosis may require blood tests, imaging, and muscle testing.

Immune Privileged Sites

Body areas where immune activity is locally limited or carefully controlled, such as parts of the eye, brain, and testes. This protection helps reduce damage to delicate tissues, but it does not mean these areas are completely cut off from immune defenses.

Immune Reconstitution Inflammatory Syndrome

Worsening inflammation that can occur as the immune system begins to recover, often soon after HIV treatment starts. The recovering immune system may react strongly to an infection that was already present, such as tuberculosis or cryptococcosis.

Alternate Names:
IRIS; Immune Restoration Disease

Immune-Related Adverse Event

An inflammatory or autoimmune toxicity caused by immune checkpoint blockade or another immune-activating cancer treatment. It may affect skin, bowel, liver, endocrine organs, lungs, heart, kidneys, or nervous system and often requires treatment-specific immunosuppression.

Immune Response

The body's reaction to an infection, foreign substance, or abnormal cell. It includes rapid defenses such as inflammation and slower, targeted responses involving antibodies and immune cells that remember previous exposures.

Immune Status

The current strength and activity of a person's immune defenses, including protection from previous infection or vaccination and effects of disease, medicines, nutrition, or cancer treatment. It helps estimate infection risk and vaccine response.

Immune System

The body's network of cells, tissues, organs, and proteins that recognizes and responds to infections, abnormal cells, and harmful substances. It includes rapid innate defenses and learned adaptive defenses; overactivity can cause allergy or autoimmunity, while weakness increases infection risk.

Immune Thrombocytopenia

An autoimmune blood disorder in which the body's immune system mistakenly attacks and destroys its own blood-clotting cells (platelets), while also slowing new platelet production in the bone marrow. Having too few platelets prevents normal clotting, increasing the risk of easy or excessive bruising, tiny pinpoint red spots on the skin (petechiae), frequent nosebleeds, bleeding gums, or heavier menstrual bleeding.

Alternate Names:
ITP; Idiopathic Thrombocytopenic Purpura; Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura

Immune Thrombocytopenia in Pregnancy

An autoimmune disorder in which antibodies destroy platelets, causing a low platelet count and sometimes bruising or bleeding. Pregnancy may complicate diagnosis and delivery planning; treatment and platelet targets depend on bleeding, counts, timing, and planned anesthesia.

Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura

Older name; see *Immune Thrombocytopenia*.

Immune Tolerance

The ability of the immune system to avoid attacking the body's own tissues while still responding to infections. Failure of tolerance can contribute to autoimmune disease; excessive tolerance can allow some cancers or infections to persist.

Immunity

The body's ability to recognize and defend against infections or other foreign substances. Protection may be present from birth, develop after infection or vaccination, or be provided temporarily by transferred antibodies.

Immunization

The process of acquiring protection against an infectious disease through active or passive immunity. Active immunity develops after exposure to an antigen, including through vaccination or infection; passive immunity follows transfer of antibodies, such as maternal antibodies or immunoglobulin. Vaccination is a means of active immunization.

Immunizations

Alternate plural form; see *Immunization*.

Immunizations For People With Diabetes

Vaccination schedules for people with diabetes vary with age, health, prior vaccination, and local public-health guidance. Diabetes can increase the risk of severe illness from some vaccine-preventable infections.

Immunoassay

A laboratory test that uses the specific binding between an antibody and its target to detect or measure substances such as hormones, medicines, proteins, antigens, or other antibodies in a sample.

Immunoassays

Alternate plural; see *Immunoassay*.

Immunoblast Count

An immunoblast count measures activated lymphocytes, usually in a tissue or blood sample, and may help evaluate immune responses or lymphoid disease.

Immunoblastic Lymphadenopathy

A historical name used for angioimmunoblastic lymphadenopathy, now classified as nodal T-follicular helper cell lymphoma, angioimmunoblastic-type. Older use of the term was not always consistent, so it should not replace the specific diagnosis based on biopsy and current lymphoma classification.

Immunoblotting

Immunoblotting, or Western blotting, separates proteins by electrophoresis and detects a target with specific antibodies; band pattern and intensity are interpreted with controls and clinical context.

Immunochemistry

The study or laboratory measurement of biological molecules using specific antigen-antibody reactions, including immunoassays and immunostaining.

Immunocompetence

The ability of the immune system to recognize harmful or foreign substances and produce an effective, appropriately controlled response. Reduced immunocompetence can increase infection risk and weaken responses to vaccines.

Immunocompetent

Having an immune system capable of mounting an appropriate response to common infectious or foreign antigens.

Immunocompromised

Having weakened or impaired immune defenses because of disease, medication, cancer treatment, transplantation, or another cause, increasing susceptibility to some infections and complications.

Immunocompromised Host

A person whose immune defenses are weakened by an inherited disorder, infection, cancer, organ failure, malnutrition, or immune-suppressing treatment. Such a person may develop unusual, severe, or repeated infections and may have fewer typical symptoms.

Immunocompromised Pneumonia

Pulmonary parenchymal infection occurring in patients with congenital or acquired immunodeficiencies (such as HIV, chemotherapy-induced neutropenia, or organ transplantation). Frequently caused by opportunistic pathogens including *Pneumocystis jirovecii*, fungi, and cytomegalovirus.

Alternate Names:
Immunocompromised Host Pneumonia

Immunoconjugate

A therapeutic or diagnostic molecule in which an antibody or other targeting protein is chemically linked to a drug, toxin, enzyme, or imaging agent.

Immunocytochemistry

A laboratory method using labeled antibodies to identify specific proteins or antigens within cells or tissue sections.

Immunodeficiency

A condition in which part of the immune system is missing, weakened, or does not work properly. It may be inherited or caused by illness, medicines, cancer treatment, poor nutrition, or infection and can lead to repeated or severe infections.

Immunodeficiency And Infections

A weakened immune system increases the risk of infections that are unusually severe, repeated, persistent, or caused by organisms that rarely affect healthy people. Causes include inherited disorders, HIV, cancer treatment, transplantation, and immune-suppressing medicines.

Immunodeficiency Diseases

Alternate name; see *Immunodeficiency*.

Immunodeficiency Disorders

Alternate name; see *Immunodeficiency*.

Immunodeficiency with Ataxia Telangiectasia

Alternate name; see *Ataxia Telangiectasia*.

Immunoelectrophoresis

A laboratory method that separates proteins by electrophoresis and identifies them with specific antibodies, often to study immunoglobulins.

Immunoelectrophoresis – Blood

Alternate name; see *Immunoelectrophoresis*.

Immunofixation Blood Test

A blood test that identifies and types monoclonal immunoglobulins, helping evaluate monoclonal gammopathy, multiple myeloma, and related plasma-cell disorders.

Immunofluorescence

A laboratory method that uses fluorescently labeled antibodies to show specific proteins, germs, or immune deposits in cells, tissues, or body fluids when viewed with a special microscope.

Immunofluorescence Technique

Alternate name; see *Immunofluorescence*.

Immunogenetics

The study of how genes influence immune-system development, function, and disease. It includes inherited susceptibility to autoimmune disease, differences in immune responses, and genetic matching for transplantation.

Immunogenicity

The ability of an antigen, vaccine, or other substance to provoke an immune response, including antibody or cellular responses.

Immunoglobulin

A protein made by immune cells that recognizes a particular foreign substance, germ, or abnormal cell. Antibodies can block harmful targets, mark them for removal, or activate other immune defenses.

Alternate Names:
Antibody

Immunoglobulin A

An antibody found mainly in mucus, saliva, tears, breast milk, and intestinal fluid. It protects surfaces exposed to the outside world and helps prevent germs from attaching and entering tissues.

Immunoglobulin A Deficiency

An immune deficiency in which IgA levels are markedly reduced or absent, while other immunoglobulin classes may be normal. Some people have recurrent respiratory or gastrointestinal infections, allergies, or autoimmune disease, while others have few symptoms.

Immunoglobulin D

A type of antibody found in very small amounts in the blood and on the surface of some B cells. Its exact role is not fully understood, but it may help regulate immune responses in the airways and other tissues.

Immunoglobulin E

A type of antibody involved in allergies and the body's response to some parasites, such as worms. It can attach to certain immune cells. When an allergen activates these cells, they release chemicals that may cause itching, swelling, more mucus, wheezing, or other allergy symptoms.

Alternate Names:
IgE

Immunoglobulin E Test

A blood test measuring total or allergen-specific IgE antibodies to evaluate allergic disorders, atopy, or parasitic infections; see *Immunoglobulin E*.

Immunoglobulin G

The most common antibody in blood and tissue fluid, helping protect against many infections. It can remain after infection or vaccination, cross the placenta during pregnancy, and sometimes cause harmful immune reactions.

Immunoglobulin G4-Related Disease

A long-term immune disorder that can cause inflammation and scar-like growths in organs such as the pancreas, tear or salivary glands, bile ducts, kidneys, and tissues behind the abdomen. Diagnosis usually combines symptoms, imaging, blood tests, and sometimes a tissue sample; a high IgG4 blood level alone does not establish the disease.

Alternate Names:
IgG4-RD; IgG4-Related Systemic Disease

Immunoglobulin G Deficiency

Reduced IgG production or function that can impair antibody-mediated defense and lead to recurrent sinopulmonary or other infections. Evaluation usually considers IgG subclasses, vaccine responses, and associated immune abnormalities.

Immunoglobulin Isotype

The class of an antibody, determined by its constant region. The main isotypes are IgG, IgA, IgM, IgD, and IgE; each has different roles and locations in immune defense.

Immunoglobulin M

A large antibody usually produced early after a new infection or other immune challenge. It helps activate immune defenses and can be measured in blood, but a high result does not by itself prove a recent infection.

Immunoglobulin M Deficiency

An uncommon antibody deficiency characterized

by persistently low IgM with otherwise variable immunoglobulin levels. It may be associated with recurrent infections, allergy, or autoimmune disease.

Immunoglobulin Replacement Therapy

Treatment that supplies pooled antibodies through a vein or under the skin when a person's immune system makes too few effective antibodies. It can reduce recurrent infections in selected inherited or acquired antibody deficiencies; headache, fever, and infusion reactions may occur.

Immunohemolysis

Destruction of red blood cells by an immune reaction involving antibodies, complement, or both. It may occur in autoimmune hemolytic anemia, incompatible transfusion reactions, or other antibody-mediated disorders.

Immunohistochemistry

A laboratory method that uses specially marked antibodies to find particular proteins in a tissue sample. It helps identify tumor type, infection, or immune disease and can guide treatment choices.

Immunologic Adjuvant

A substance added to some vaccines to strengthen or guide the immune response. It may improve protection but can also increase temporary pain, swelling, fever, or other vaccine reactions.

Immunologically Privileged Site

A body area where immune responses are partly limited, helping protect delicate tissues from inflammation while still allowing important defense against infection.

Immunological Memory

Alternate name; see *Immunologic Memory*.

Immunological Synapse

The organized contact point where an immune cell meets a target or another immune cell. Signals gathered at this contact help decide whether the immune cell should become active.

Immunological Tolerance

Alternate name; see *Immune Tolerance*.

Immunologic Factor

A substance, cell, gene, or process that affects immune-system activity or control. Examples include antibodies, immune cells, signaling proteins, inherited traits, medicines, and conditions that alter defense against disease.

Immunologic Memory

The capacity of the adaptive immune system to respond more rapidly and strongly after re-exposure to an antigen because of long-lived memory lymphocytes.

Immunologic Skin Test

An immunologic skin test places a small amount of an antigen or allergen in or on the skin to assess immune reactivity, such as allergy or tuberculosis exposure.

Immunologic Surveillance

The immune system's ongoing detection and removal of abnormal, infected, or damaged cells. This protection helps control infections and may recognize early cancerous changes, although it is not always successful.

Immunologic Technique

A laboratory or clinical method that uses antibodies, antigens, or immune reactions to detect or measure a substance.

Immunologic Test

An immunologic test examines immune cells, antibodies, antigens, or immune-related proteins to help evaluate infection, allergy, autoimmune disease, or immune deficiency.

Immunology

The study of the immune system, its normal functions, and its disorders. Clinical immunology focuses on allergy, immunodeficiency, autoimmunity, and abnormal immune responses to infection or trans-

planted tissue. Basic immunology also investigates immune cells, molecules, and mechanisms.

Immunomodulation

Modification of immune activity to enhance, suppress, or redirect an immune response. Immunomodulatory medicines are used in cancer, autoimmune disease, transplantation, and infection but may increase susceptibility to infection or other adverse effects.

Immunomodulators

Medicines or other treatments that change immune-system activity. Depending on the treatment, they may increase, reduce, or redirect immune responses and are used for conditions such as cancer, autoimmune disease, and some infections. Effects and risks vary by treatment.

Alternate Names:
Immunomodulator; Immune-Modifying Medicines

Immunomodulators In Dermatology

Medicines that adjust local immune activity to treat conditions such as eczema and other inflammatory skin diseases. Topical calcineurin inhibitors are steroid-sparing options and may cause burning or irritation.

Immunomodulatory

Describing a treatment or substance that changes immune activity. It may stimulate, suppress, or otherwise regulate the immune response, depending on the medicine and condition.

Immunophenotyping

A laboratory method that identifies cells by the proteins on or inside them, usually using flow cytometry or stained tissue. It helps classify leukemias and lymphomas and evaluate some immune disorders.

Immunoprotein

A protein involved in immune defense or immune regulation, such as an antibody, complement protein, cytokine, or antigen-presenting molecule. Immunoproteins identify threats, coordinate immune cells, or help remove damaged or infected material.

Immunoradiometric Assay

A laboratory test using radioactive labels on antibodies to measure a specific substance, such as a hormone, protein, or other marker.

Immunoregulation

Control of the strength, duration, and target of immune responses, including activation, suppression, and tolerance. Abnormal immunoregulation contributes to autoimmunity, allergy, immunodeficiency, and chronic inflammation.

Immunosenescence

Age-related changes in immune defenses that can increase susceptibility to some infections, reduce vaccine responses, and alter inflammation. The effects vary with chronic disease, nutrition, medicines, and overall function.

Immunosuppressants

Medicines that reduce immune-system activity. They are used after transplantation and for selected autoimmune or inflammatory disorders, but can increase susceptibility to infection and other adverse effects.

Immunosuppression

Reduced immune-system activity caused by disease, medicines, cancer treatment, or another condition. It can prevent rejection of a transplant or control autoimmune disease but increases susceptibility to infections and some cancers.

Immunosuppression In Transplant

Treatment that reduces immune activity to prevent rejection of a transplanted organ. It can increase infection and cancer risk, affect kidney or liver function, and cause other medicine-related complications.

Immunosuppression Screening

Checks before immune-suppressing treatment to identify infections, cancer risks, organ problems, pregnancy when relevant, and missing vaccinations. Tests may include tuberculosis, hepatitis B or C, HIV, blood counts, and liver and kidney tests.

Immunosuppressive

Describing a medicine, treatment, or condition that reduces immune-system activity. Immunosuppression can prevent transplant rejection or control autoimmune disease, but it may increase the risk of infection, some cancers, and reduced vaccine responses.

Immunotherapy

Cancer treatment that helps the immune system recognize or attack cancer cells, or supplies immune cells or antibodies that do so. Main approaches include checkpoint medicines, engineered immune cells, antibodies, and immune-stimulating treatments. Benefits and side effects depend on the cancer and treatment.

Immunotherapy And Biologic Treatments

Treatments made from or designed to affect living biological systems, including antibodies and other medicines that adjust immune activity. They are used for selected cancers, autoimmune diseases, and inflammatory disorders and may increase infection or organ-inflammation risk.

Immunotherapy For Cancer

Cancer treatment that stimulates, restores, redirects, or supplies immune activity to recognize and attack malignant cells, including immune-checkpoint inhibitors, cellular therapies, and antibodies.

Immunotherapy In Dermatology

Treatment that changes immune activity to manage selected skin cancers or inflammatory skin diseases. The treatment and its risks depend on the diagnosis; immune-based cancer medicines can also inflame normal organs.

Immunotoxicity

Harm to immune-system function caused by chemicals, medicines, infections, or other exposures. It may weaken defenses, trigger excessive sensitivity, cause autoimmunity, or change responses to vaccines and infections.

Immunotoxin

A targeted toxin made by linking a toxic protein or drug to an antibody or binding molecule that directs it toward selected cells.

Immunoturbidimetry

A laboratory method that measures cloudiness produced when antibodies react with a target antigen, allowing estimation of the target's concentration.

Impacted

Firmly wedged or unable to move from its normal position, as with an impacted tooth or stool. The result may cause pain, blockage, inflammation, infection, or damage to nearby tissues.

Impacted Fracture

A fracture in which one broken bone fragment is driven firmly into another, often producing relative stability but sometimes causing shortening or deformity.

Impacted Tooth

A tooth that cannot emerge normally because it is blocked by bone, gum, or another tooth. Wisdom teeth and upper canine teeth are commonly affected and may cause pain, infection, decay, cysts, or damage to neighboring teeth.

Impacted Wisdom Teeth

Wisdom teeth that cannot emerge normally because they are blocked by bone, gum, or another tooth.

Alternate Names:
Impacted Third Molars; Third Molar Impaction

Impaction

Blockage caused by material that is firmly lodged, such as hardened stool, a foreign object, or an impacted tooth. Symptoms depend on the site and may include pain, swelling, vomiting, or inability to pass contents.

Impaired Fasting Glucose

A fasting blood-glucose level above normal but below the range used to diagnose diabetes. It indicates

increased future diabetes risk and may improve with weight management, activity, and treatment of risk factors.

Impaired Glucose Tolerance

A blood-glucose level that is higher than normal two hours after drinking a measured glucose solution but below the range used to diagnose diabetes. It indicates increased future risk of type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease.

Impaired Smell

Reduced or absent ability to detect odors, called hyposmia or anosmia, caused by nasal obstruction, viral injury, head trauma, neurodegeneration, medications, or other disease.

Impaired Taste

Impaired taste is reduced, distorted, or absent ability to taste and may result from infection, medicines, oral disease, nerve injury, or changes in smell.

IMP Dehydrogenase

An enzyme that helps cells make guanosine nucleotides, building blocks needed for DNA and RNA. Blocking it can slow the growth of immune cells, which is why some immunosuppressive medicines target this pathway.

Impedance Hearing Testing

A group of tests, including tympanometry, that measure the movement of the eardrum and middle-ear function.

Impedance Plethysmography

A test that measures changes in a limb's electrical resistance as its blood volume changes. It has been used to assess venous blood flow.

Impella Device

A temporary heart pump placed through a blood vessel or during surgery. Depending on the model, it can support the left or right side of the heart by moving blood from a heart chamber into a major artery. It is used in selected cases of severe heart failure or during heart procedures.

Imperforate Anus

A birth difference in which the anus is absent, closed, or not connected normally to the rectum. A newborn may not pass stool and may develop abdominal swelling; other spine, heart, kidney, limb, or digestive differences can occur.

Imperforate Anus Repair

Surgery to create or reposition an anal opening and connect the rectum so stool can pass normally in a baby born with an absent or blocked anus. Some babies need temporary bowel diversion; follow-up assesses healing, constipation, and bowel control.

Imperforate Hymen

A birth difference in which the hymen completely covers the vaginal opening. After puberty, menstrual blood may collect behind it, causing absent periods, monthly pelvic pain, difficulty urinating, or a pelvic swelling.

Imperforate Vagina

A congenital blockage or discontinuity of the vaginal canal, often caused by vaginal atresia or a transverse vaginal septum. After puberty, menstrual blood may collect behind the blockage, causing absent periods, cyclic pelvic pain, or a pelvic mass.

Impetigo

A contagious superficial bacterial skin infection, usually caused by *Staphylococcus aureus* or group A *Streptococcus*. Nonbullous lesions often progress from sores to characteristic honey-colored crusts; bullous impetigo causes fragile fluid-filled blisters. It is common in children but can occur at any age.

Alternate Names:
School Sores; Impetigo Contagiosa

Impingement Syndrome

Pain and restricted movement caused when a tendon or other soft tissue is compressed between bones, commonly in the shoulder during elevation of the arm.

Impingement Syndrome of the Shoulder

Shoulder pain caused when tendons or a fluid-filled cushion beneath the shoulder blade become crowded during arm movement. Pain and limited movement are common.

Alternate Names:
Subacromial Impingement; Rotator Cuff Impingement

Implant

A medical device, tissue, or material placed inside the body to replace, support, monitor, or deliver treatment.

Implantable Cardioverter Defibrillator

Variant spelling; see *Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator*.

Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator

A small, battery-powered electronic device surgically placed under the skin of the chest to protect people at high risk of sudden cardiac arrest. It continuously monitors the heart's electrical rhythm; if it detects a dangerously fast or chaotic heartbeat in the lower chambers (ventricles), it automatically delivers an electric shock to reset the heart to a normal rhythm.

Alternate Names:
ICD; Automated Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator (AICD)

Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator Placement

The surgical insertion of a specialized battery-powered device under the skin connected to cardiac leads that continuously monitors heart rhythm and delivers electric shocks or pacing to terminate life-threatening ventricular arrhythmias; see *Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator*.

Implantable Defibrillator

A surgically implanted device that detects dangerous ventricular arrhythmias and delivers pacing or an electrical shock to restore an effective rhythm.

Implantable Glucose Sensor

A sensor placed under the skin that measures glucose in interstitial fluid and sends readings to a receiver, reader, or insulin-delivery system. It supports continuous or intermittently scanned glucose monitoring.

Implantable Loop Recorder

A small device placed under the skin of the chest to record heart rhythm for months or years. It helps detect intermittent abnormal rhythms when fainting, palpitations, or a stroke remains unexplained by shorter monitoring.

Implantable Port

A small reservoir placed under the skin and connected to a tube in a large vein. It provides repeated access for medicines, fluids, blood products, or nutrition without a new vein puncture each time; infection, clotting, blockage, or damage can occur.

Implantable Venous Access Port

A totally subcutaneous long-term central venous access device consisting of a silicone or titanium injection reservoir septum connected to a central catheter, accessed percutaneously using a non-coring Huber needle.

Alternate Names:
Port-a-Cath; Subcutaneous Infusion Port; Mediport; Venous Access Port

Implant-Associated Infection

Infection involving an implanted device or the tissue around it. Germs may stick to the device and form a protective layer, so treatment may require antibiotics, drainage, or removal or replacement of the device.

Implantation

The stage of early pregnancy when a fertilized egg attaches to and begins growing into the lining of the uterus, usually about a week after fertilization. It allows the developing pregnancy to receive support from the placenta.

Implantation Procedure

Placement of a device, tissue, medicine-delivery system, or other material inside the body for treatment or support. Examples include joint, dental, heart, and breast implants; risks include bleeding, infection, movement, failure, or rejection of donor tissue.

Implant-Based Breast Reconstruction

Breast reconstruction using a saline- or silicone-filled implant, sometimes after a temporary tissue expander is placed. The approach depends on the person's anatomy, treatment, and preferences.

Alternate Names:
Prosthetic Breast Reconstruction; Implant Breast Reconstruction

Implant Failure

Loss of an implant's ability to work properly or remain safely in place. Causes include infection, breakage, loosening, wear, movement, blockage, material damage, or problems with the surrounding tissue.

Implants

Medical devices, materials, or tissues placed in the body to replace, support, monitor, or deliver treatment. Possible problems include infection, rejection, movement, breakage, or failure.

Implant Sterilization

A validated process that removes or kills all microorganisms, including spores, from an implant or implantable device before use. The method is chosen according to the device's material and design.

Implant-Supported Prosthesis

A fixed or removable dental prosthesis that is supported or retained by one or more dental implants.

Importance Weight

An importance weight is a statistical weight used to adjust observations so a sample better represents a target population or distribution.

Impotence

Older term; see *Erectile Dysfunction*.

Impotence (Erection Problems)

Alternate name for erectile dysfunction, the persistent inability to obtain or maintain an erection adequate for sexual activity; see *Erectile Dysfunction*.

Impression

The concluding section of a medical or imaging report that summarizes the most important findings, their likely meaning, and possible next steps.

Imprinting

A pattern of gene expression determined by whether a gene copy was inherited from the mother or father.

Impulse

An impulse is a brief signal or force; in physiology it commonly refers to an electrical signal travelling along a nerve or through the heart.

Impulse Control Disorder

A class of psychiatric conditions characterized by a persistent failure to resist an impulse, drive, or temptation to perform an act harmful to oneself or others, including kleptomania, pyromania, and intermittent explosive disorder.

Impulse Oscillometry

A breathing test that applies tiny pressure waves while a person breathes normally. It estimates how easily air moves through the lungs and can help assess asthma, chronic lung disease, or small-airway problems, especially when forceful breathing is difficult.

Impulsive Behavior

Impulsive behavior is action with limited forethought or inhibition despite possible harm and may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, substance-related, or developmental conditions.

Impulsivity

A tendency to act quickly without adequate consideration of consequences or difficulty delaying a response; it can occur in ADHD, mania, substance use, and other conditions.

In

In clinical measurements, an abbreviation for inch or inches; the same letters may have other meanings in different contexts.

Inactivated Vaccines

Vaccines made from microorganisms that have been killed or from parts of them. They cannot reproduce or cause the infection they are designed to prevent, but they may need several doses or booster doses to maintain protection.

Inactivator

A substance or process that makes a biological agent inactive. Inactivators may disable viruses, toxins, enzymes, or medicines and are used in immunity, laboratory testing, sterilization, and treatment.

Inamrinone

Inamrinone is an intravenous medicine that increases heart contraction and widens blood vessels; it was used short term in severe heart failure but can cause low blood pressure and abnormal rhythms.

Inanition

Severe physical depletion caused by inadequate food or nutrient intake, often accompanied by weight loss, weakness, dehydration, and metabolic disturbance. Causes may include starvation, malabsorption, chronic disease, or inability to eat.

Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion

Older name for a disorder in which excess vasopressin makes the body retain water and lowers blood sodium; see *Syndrome of Inappropriate Antidiuresis (SIAD)*.

Inappropriate Sinus Tachycardia

A condition in which the heart's normal pacemaker beats too fast at rest or speeds up more than expected with mild activity, without another clear cause such as fever, anemia, or an overactive thyroid. It may cause palpitations, dizziness, tiredness, or shortness of breath.

Alternate Names:
IST

Inborn Error Of Metabolism

An inherited disorder in which an enzyme, transporter, or other protein needed for body chemistry does not work correctly. Harmful substances may accumulate or essential substances may be lacking, causing illness from infancy or later in life.

Inborn Errors Of Immunity

Inherited disorders that impair one or more parts of the immune system. They can cause repeated, unusually severe, or unusual infections, as well as autoimmunity, inflammation, allergy, or increased cancer risk.

Inborn Errors of Metabolism

Alternate name; see *Inborn Error Of Metabolism*.

Inbreed

To reproduce between genetically related individuals; inbreeding can increase the chance that recessive inherited disorders will occur.

Inbreeding

Reproduction between people who share a recent ancestor. It increases the chance that a child inherits two copies of the same recessive disease-causing gene variant.

Incarcerated Femoral Hernia

A femoral hernia whose contents cannot be returned through the femoral canal into the abdomen. The narrow, firm opening increases the risk of bowel obstruction and strangulation, in which blood supply to the trapped tissue is cut off.

Incarcerated Hernia

A hernia whose protruded tissue cannot be returned to the abdominal cavity. It may progress to strangulation and loss of blood supply.

Incentive Spirometry

A breathing device that provides visual feedback while a person inhales slowly and deeply. It may be used with coughing, mobilization, and other measures to encourage lung expansion after illness or surgery; it is a lung-expansion exercise and is not the same as diagnostic spirometry.

Incest

Sexual activity or reproduction between close biological relatives. It can involve abuse or coercion and increases the chance of inherited disorders in children; associated concerns include medical, psychological, and safeguarding needs.

Incidence

The number of new cases of a disease or event in a defined population during a specified period. It describes the chance of developing the condition during that period and differs from prevalence.

Incidental Finding

An unexpected result discovered during an examination or test performed for another reason. It may be harmless or important; follow-up depends on what was found, its appearance, symptoms, and personal risk factors.

Incidentaloma

An unexpected mass or abnormality found during imaging or another test performed for a different reason. It may be harmless or important, so follow-up depends on its size, appearance, location, growth, and the person's risks.

Incised Wound

A cut made by a sharp object such as a knife, piece of glass, or surgical instrument. It usually has straight, clean edges and may damage skin, blood vessels, nerves, tendons, or deeper organs.

Incision

A deliberate cut made by a healthcare professional through the skin or another tissue, usually during surgery or to allow drainage. The wound is closed or left to heal according to its size, location, contamination, and purpose.

Incisional Biopsy

Surgical removal of only part of a lesion for diagnosis, generally used when the lesion is too large or located where complete removal would be inappropriate as an initial procedure.

Incisional Hernia

A hernia through a weakness in a previous surgical incision. It may appear as a bulge that becomes more prominent with standing or straining. Risk factors include wound infection, obesity, smoking, poor nutrition, chronic cough, and repeated surgery.

Incision and Drainage

A procedure that opens an abscess, a pocket of pus, so it can drain. It is often done with local anesthetic. A small drain or packing may be used to keep the opening from closing too soon; some infections also need antibiotics.

Alternate Names:
I&D; Abscess Drainage; Incision and Drainage of Abscess

Incision Care After Surgery

Care practices for a surgical wound, including keeping it clean and protected and watching for infection or separation. Care may involve dressing changes and limits on bathing or activity during healing.

Incisor

One of the specialized anterior teeth in mammalian dentition adapted primarily for cutting, shearing, and gnawing food during mastication. In permanent adult human dentition, there are eight incisors in total (four maxillary and four mandibular, subdivided into two central incisors and two lateral incisors per arch; Universal Numbering System teeth 7, 8, 9, 10, 23, 24, 25, and 26). Anatomically characterized by a single conical root, a chisel-shaped incisal edge, a

lingual fossa, and a prominent cingulum. Primary incisors typically erupt between 6 and 12 months of age, with permanent successors erupting between 6 and 9 years. Highly susceptible to coronal fractures from facial trauma, dental caries, incisal attrition, and periodontal alveolar bone loss.

Incisors

Plural form; see *Incisor*.

Inclusion Body

A visible collection of material inside a cell. It may consist of viral parts, stored fats or sugars, or abnormal proteins; its appearance can help laboratory specialists identify infection, cell injury, or another disease.

Inclusion Body Myositis

A slowly progressive muscle disease, usually beginning after age 50, that causes uneven weakness of the thigh muscles and finger-bending muscles. It can lead to falls and difficulty gripping or swallowing; treatment focuses on safety, exercise, and support.

Inclusion Conjunctivitis

Conjunctivitis caused by *Chlamydia trachomatis*, usually presenting with persistent discharge, follicular inflammation, and sometimes genital infection. In newborns it can be associated with infection elsewhere and complications.

Incompetence

Failure of a structure to close or function adequately; examples include valvular incompetence of the heart and cervical incompetence during pregnancy.

Incompetent Cervix

Painless shortening or opening of the cervix during the middle or late part of pregnancy, without normal labor. It can cause pregnancy loss or premature birth and is assessed with history and ultrasound.

Incomplete Abortion

A pregnancy loss in which some pregnancy tissue remains in the uterus. It may cause vaginal bleeding, cramping, and an open cervix.

Incomplete Heart Block

A cardiac conduction disturbance in which supraventricular impulses are conducted to the ventricles with delay (first-degree AV block) or intermittent failure (second-degree AV block Mobitz I or II), distinguishing it from complete (third-degree) AV block where no impulses conduct.

Alternate Names:
Partial Heart Block

Incomplete Miscarriage

Partial loss of a pregnancy in which some pregnancy tissue remains inside the uterus, potentially causing bleeding, pain, infection, or continued pregnancy symptoms.

Incomplete Ossification

Failure of bone or cartilage to mineralize or develop fully. It may be part of normal development or result from genetic, metabolic, nutritional, or skeletal disorders and is interpreted with age, imaging, and laboratory findings.

Incontinence

Involuntary loss of control over urination, bowel movements, or both. It may result from weakened muscles, nerve disease, infection, constipation, childbirth, prostate problems, medicines, mobility limits, or other conditions.

Incontinence in Men

Involuntary leakage of urine in a man. It may occur with urgency from an overactive bladder, leakage during exertion after prostate surgery, or overflow when the bladder does not empty fully. Causes include prostate treatment, bladder overactivity, urinary blockage, and nerve disorders.

Incontinence/OAB

Urinary incontinence associated with overactive bladder symptoms such as urgency, frequency, or nocturia; see *Overactive Bladder* and *Urinary Incontinence*.

Incontinentia Pigmenti

An X-linked dominant disorder affecting skin, teeth, eyes, and the nervous system, caused by pathogenic variants in IKBKG. Skin lesions evolve through vesicular, verrucous, hyperpigmented, and atrophic stages and may be associated with retinal disease or seizures.

Incoordinatio

Lack of coordination between muscles or body movements; the term is often used in older medical language.

Incoordination

Impaired ability to perform smooth, accurate, coordinated movements, often called ataxia. Causes include cerebellar disease, sensory loss, vestibular disorders, intoxication, medicines, and other neurologic conditions.

Increased Appetite

An abnormally excessive desire for food or marked increase in caloric intake, seen in endocrine disorders (such as diabetes mellitus and hyperthyroidism), hypothalamic injury, psychiatric illness, or medication side effects.

Alternate Names:
Hyperphagia; Polyphagia

Increased Head Circumference

Increased head circumference means head size above the expected range for age and sex and may reflect familial size, hydrocephalus, swelling, or a genetic condition.

Increased Intracranial Pressure

Alternate name; see *Intracranial Hypertension*.

Increased Libido

Increased libido is heightened sexual desire that may be normal or associated with hormones, medicines, mood elevation, neurologic disease, or substance use.

Increased Osteoid

Increased osteoid is excess unmineralized bone matrix, seen when bone formation outpaces mineralization as in osteomalacia or some metabolic disorders.

Increased Vascular Permeability

A change during inflammation that makes small blood vessels leaky. Fluid, proteins, and immune cells then move into nearby tissue, causing swelling, redness, warmth, and sometimes pain.

Increment

An increase or stepwise change in an amount, measurement, dose, or treatment intensity. In treatment, its size and timing affect benefit and risk.

Incretin Effect

The physiological augmentation of insulin secretion observed after oral glucose administration compared to an identical intravenous glucose load, mediated by gastrointestinal incretin peptides such as glucagon-like peptide-1 (GLP-1) and glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide (GIP).

Alternate Names:
Gut Incretin Response; Oral Glucose Insulinotropic Effect

Incretins

Incretins are gut hormones, mainly GLP-1 and GIP, released after meals that enhance glucose-dependent insulin secretion; GLP-1 also suppresses glucagon, slows gastric emptying, and reduces appetite.

Incubation

Incubation is the time between exposure to an infectious agent and the appearance of symptoms.

Incubation Period

The time between exposure to an infectious agent and the beginning of symptoms. It varies with the organism, dose, route of exposure, and person's immune response.

Incubator

A controlled-environment chamber culturing mi-

croorganisms, cells, or tissues at defined temperature, humidity, and atmospheric composition.

Incus

The incus, commonly known as the anvil, is the middle ossicle of the three bones in the middle ear, articulating with the malleus at the incudomalleolar joint and with the stapes at the incudostapedial joint.

Indapamide

Indapamide is a thiazide-like diuretic used mainly for hypertension; it promotes renal sodium excretion and may cause hyponatraemia, hypokalaemia, dehydration, hyperuricaemia, or photosensitivity.

Indel Mutation

A genetic change in which one or more DNA building blocks are inserted or deleted. If the number is not a multiple of three, it can disrupt the protein reading frame.

Independence

The ability to perform activities and make decisions without assistance, although a person may still use devices, adaptations, or occasional support.

Indeterminate

Indeterminate means not definitively classified or interpreted because available findings are insufficient, conflicting, or nonspecific.

Index of Microcirculatory Resistance

An invasive measure of resistance in the coronary microvessels during maximal vasodilation, calculated from distal coronary pressure and the hyperemic mean transit time of a saline indicator. An increased value can indicate coronary microvascular dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
IMR

India Immunization Schedule

The Government of India's Universal Immunization Programme schedule, which lists vaccines and timing for groups including children and pregnant people. The schedule is updated periodically.

Indiana Type Amyloidosis (Type II)

Hereditary transthyretin amyloid polyneuropathy type II, also called Indiana/Swiss type, caused by a pathogenic transthyretin variant and often involving peripheral nerves.

Indian Tick Typhus

A tick-borne rickettsial infection endemic to India and South Asia, caused by Rickettsia conorii subsp. indica and transmitted by brown dog ticks (Rhipicephalus sanguineus). It typically manifests with acute high fever, severe headache, generalized maculopapular rash involving palms and soles, and occasionally a black necrotic inoculation eschar (tache noire) at the bite site.

Alternate Names:
Indian Spotted Fever; Rickettsia Conorii Indica Infection

Indican

Indican is a compound formed from tryptophan metabolism and excreted in urine; abnormal levels may occur with intestinal bacterial overgrowth or metabolic disease.

Indicate

To show, suggest, or point to a finding or conclusion; an indication is a clinical reason for using a test, treatment, or procedure.

Indication

A clinical condition, symptom, or question that provides the reason for performing a test, procedure, or treatment.

Indigestion

Common term for dyspepsia: discomfort or burning in the upper abdomen that may include early fullness, bloating, belching, or nausea. Persistent symptoms, bleeding, weight loss, vomiting, anemia, or difficulty swallowing may indicate a more serious cause.

Indigo Carmine

Indigo carmine is a blue dye used in selected medical procedures to visualize urinary or other fluid flow and in laboratory staining.

Indirect Antiglobulin Test

A blood test that detects antibodies able to react with red blood cells. It is used before transfusion and during pregnancy to identify antibodies that could harm donated blood or a fetus's red cells.

Indirect Calorimetry

A test that measures oxygen use and carbon-dioxide production to estimate how much energy the body uses at rest. It can help determine nutrition needs when usual calculations are unreliable.

Indirect Coombs Test

An in vitro laboratory diagnostic test used to detect circulating, unattached IgG antibodies against red blood cell surface antigens in the patient's serum, commonly utilized in prenatal maternal Rh-D alloimmunization screening and pre-transfusion compatibility crossmatching.

Alternate Names:
Indirect Antiglobulin Test; IAT

Indirect Inguinal Hernia

An abdominal wall hernia in which abdominal viscera herniate through the deep inguinal ring lateral to the inferior epigastric vessels into the inguinal canal, resulting from congenital persistence and patent failure of closure of the embryonic processus vaginalis.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Inguinal Hernia

Indirect Veneer

A thin covering made outside the mouth and bonded to the front of a tooth to change its shape, color, or appearance. It may be made from porcelain or composite material. Tooth preparation, strength, hygiene, and long-term maintenance affect its suitability.

Indium

A metal whose radioactive isotope indium-111 is used in nuclear medicine. It can label white blood cells to help locate infection or inflammation, or be attached to other molecules used to image certain tumors.

Indium-111

A radioactive form of indium used as a tracer in selected nuclear-medicine tests. It may label white blood cells to help locate inflammation or infection, or be attached to another substance to help show certain tumors. It emits detectable radiation that is recorded by a special camera.

Indium-111 Scan

A nuclear medicine scan that uses the radioactive tracer indium-111 to make selected tissues visible. It may be attached to white blood cells to look for inflammation or infection, or to a substance that helps find some tumors.

Indium-Labelled WBC Scan

A nuclear medicine study in which a patient's white blood cells are labeled with indium-111 and reinjected to localize selected sites of inflammation or infection.

Indocyanine Green

Indocyanine green is a fluorescent dye injected intravenously to assess liver function, blood flow, and retinal or choroidal circulation.

Indocyanine Green Clearance

A dynamic liver function test measuring the elimination rate of intravenously administered indocyanine green dye from circulating plasma by hepatocytes (without enterohepatic recirculation), widely used preoperatively to calculate remnant liver functional reserve prior to major hepatic resection.

Alternate Names:
ICG Clearance

Indole

An aromatic heterocyclic organic compound with

a bicyclic structure consisting of a six-membered benzene ring fused to a five-membered nitrogen-containing pyrrole ring. Naturally biosynthesized by gut microbiota via tryptophan deamination, serving as the core bicyclic scaffold for vital endogenous neuroendocrine molecules—notably the neurotransmitter serotonin (5-hydroxytryptamine), the hormone melatonin, and indole-3-acetic acid—as well as numerous pharmacologic agents (e.g., indomethacin, ondansetron, sumatriptan). Elevated bacterial indole derivatives (such as indoxyl sulfate) act as potent uremic toxins contributing to endothelial dysfunction and vascular calcification in chronic kidney disease.

Indole-3-Carbinol

A compound formed from glucosinolates in cruciferous vegetables and studied for effects on estrogen metabolism and cancer biology.

Indolent

Slow to develop, progress, or cause symptoms; it often describes a relatively slow-growing disease or tumor.

Indolent Systemic Mastocytosis

A usually slow-progressing form of systemic mastocytosis in which abnormal mast cells accumulate in organs such as bone marrow, skin, or digestive tract; see *Systemic Mastocytosis*.

Indoles

Plural form; see *Indole*.

Indometacin

Indometacin is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and inflammation; it can cause stomach bleeding, kidney problems, and cardiovascular complications.

Indomethacin

Indomethacin is a potent NSAID used for inflammatory pain and selected acute conditions such as gout; gastrointestinal ulceration or bleeding, renal injury, cardiovascular events, and headache are important adverse effects.

Indomethacin Overdose

Toxic exposure to excessive indomethacin, which can cause nausea, vomiting, stomach bleeding, kidney injury, seizures, or other serious effects.

Indoor Allergens

Substances inside buildings that can trigger allergic or asthma symptoms, including dust mites, mold, cockroach particles, and animal dander. Exposure may cause rhinitis, conjunctivitis, wheezing, or eczema. Reduction of exposure and appropriate allergy or asthma treatment depend on the identified trigger.

Induced Abortion

Deliberate ending of a pregnancy using medicines or a procedure. The method depends mainly on pregnancy duration and clinical circumstances; possible complications include heavy bleeding and infection.

Induced Hyperthermia

Induced hyperthermia is deliberate elevation of body or tissue temperature for a therapeutic purpose, with careful monitoring to prevent heat injury.

Induced Labor

Medical initiation of uterine contractions before labor begins naturally to achieve delivery when continuing pregnancy may pose greater risk.

Induced Sputum Analysis

A test in which inhaled salty mist helps a person produce mucus from the airways. The mucus is examined for infection or inflammatory cells to help assess asthma, chronic lung disease, or bronchiectasis.

Inducible Laryngeal Obstruction

Temporary narrowing of the larynx during breathing, often during exercise or exposure to an irritant. It can cause noisy breathing, throat tightness, cough, or shortness of breath and was formerly often called vocal-cord dysfunction.

Inducing Labor

Starting childbirth artificially with medicines, breaking the amniotic sac, or other methods when continuing pregnancy may pose greater risks than delivery.

Induction

Starting a process before it begins on its own or causing it to occur. In medicine, labor induction starts uterine contractions, anesthesia induction brings about unconsciousness, and treatment induction aims to bring a disease into remission or establish immune tolerance. The term names a general process, not one specific procedure.

Induction Of Labor

Starting uterine contractions medically before labor begins on its own. It may be indicated when continuing pregnancy is riskier, using medicines or procedures that soften the cervix and encourage contractions.

Induction Therapy

The first, often intensive, part of treatment given to reduce or remove a disease. In acute leukemia, its main aim is remission, meaning that tests find no clear evidence of leukemia; further treatment is usually needed to reduce the chance of return.

Indurated

Abnormally firm or hardened when palpated, usually because of inflammation, edema, fibrosis, infiltration, or a tumor within the skin or underlying tissue.

Induration

Abnormal hardening of tissue, often detected by palpation and caused by inflammation, infection, edema, fibrosis, or a mass.

Industrial Bronchitis

Industrial bronchitis is chronic airway irritation and inflammation related to workplace dusts, fumes, or chemicals, causing cough, phlegm, and breathing limitation.

Industrial Disease

A disease caused or worsened by workplace exposures or conditions, such as chemicals, dust, noise, radiation, infection, or repetitive strain.

Industrial Health

The branch of occupational health concerned with preventing and managing illness and injury related to industrial work, workplace exposures, and working conditions.

Indwelling Catheter

A catheter left in place for ongoing drainage, infusion, monitoring, or access; urinary indwelling catheters can increase the risk of infection and tissue trauma.

Indwelling Catheter Care

Practices for maintaining a tube that remains in the bladder or another body space to drain fluid. These include keeping the tube unobstructed, reducing infection risk, and monitoring for fever, pain, blockage, or leakage.

Indwelling Pleural Catheter

A flexible tube placed through the chest wall into the space around the lung to drain fluid that keeps returning. It can allow drainage at home and relieve breathlessness, especially when cancer or a lung that cannot fully expand causes the fluid. Possible problems include infection, blockage, pain, or air leakage.

Alternate Names:
IPC; Tunneled Pleural Catheter; PleurX Catheter

Inert Gas Narcosis

Temporary slowing of thinking, judgment, coordination, or awareness caused by breathing compressed gas at depth, usually because nitrogen affects the brain at increased pressure. It may cause euphoria or confusion, becomes more likely at greater depths, and usually improves during ascent.

Alternate Names:
Nitrogen Narcosis; Rapture of the Deep

Inertia

Resistance to a change in motion; in obstetrics, uterine inertia means weak or ineffective contractions that slow labor.

Infant

An infant is a child in the first year of life, a period of rapid growth and changing feeding, immune, neurologic, and developmental needs.

Infant Botulism

A serious illness in which Clostridium botulinum bacteria grow in an infant's intestine and make a toxin. Constipation, poor feeding, weak crying, drooping eyelids, limpness, and breathing weakness can develop.

Infant Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

Cardiopulmonary resuscitation for a baby younger than 1 year who has no normal breathing or pulse. It combines chest compressions with rescue breaths; the sequence and technique depend on whether one or more rescuers are present and on current resuscitation guidelines.

Alternate Names:
Infant CPR; Pediatric Basic Life Support, Infant; BLS Infant

Infant Feeding

Provision of breast milk, appropriately prepared formula, or both to meet an infant's energy, protein, fluid, and micronutrient requirements. Feeding recommendations depend on age, growth, medical conditions, developmental readiness, and safe preparation practices.

Infant Feeding Patterns and Diet

Age-appropriate nutritional guidance for infants during the first year of life, emphasizing exclusive breastfeeding or iron-fortified infant formula for the first six months, followed by the gradual introduction of complementary solid foods.

Alternate Names:
Infant Nutrition; Infant Feeding Guidelines; Baby Feeding

Infant Formula

Infant formula is manufactured nutrition designed to provide adequate nutrients when breast milk is unavailable, insufficient, or not chosen; preparation and storage practices affect safety.

Infant Formulas

Alternate plural; see *Infant Formula*.

Infant Gynecomastia

Infant gynecomastia is temporary breast enlargement in a newborn or young infant caused by maternal or neonatal hormones and usually resolves spontaneously.

Infant Harlequin Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Neonatal Harlequin Color Change*.

Infant Hearing Loss

Congenital or early-acquired auditory impairment in infants, resulting from genetic mutations (such as connexin 26 mutations), congenital infections (cytomegalovirus, rubella), prematurity, hyperbilirubinemia, or ototoxic drug exposure. Universal newborn hearing screening enables early amplification and speech-language intervention.

Alternate Names:
Infant Hearing Impairment

Infanticide

The killing of an infant. The legal definition and classification vary by jurisdiction; in medicine, the term may appear in forensic and child-protection contexts.

Infantile Bradycardia

An unusually slow heart rate in an infant. It can occur normally during sleep, but may also signal low oxygen, infection, medicines, or a heart or conduction problem; symptoms and the infant's age determine the evaluation.

Infantile Colic

Repeated periods of prolonged crying that are hard

to soothe, without an obvious cause, in an otherwise healthy baby. It often begins in the first weeks of life and usually improves by three to four months. The exact cause is not known.

Infantile Cortical Hyperostosis (Caffey Disease)

A self-limited disorder of infancy characterized by irritability, soft-tissue swelling, and cortical thickening of affected bones. It is usually associated with COL1A1-related disease and resolves over time.

Infantile Fibrosarcoma

A rare cancer of connective or soft tissue that usually appears in a baby or young child as a growing lump. It may involve the limbs or trunk; imaging and biopsy guide treatment, which requires specialist care.

Infantile Gaucher Disease

Gaucher disease presenting in infancy, often with severe neurologic and systemic involvement; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Infantile Hemangioma

A common, noncancerous growth of blood vessels that appears during the first weeks of life. It often grows for a time and then gradually shrinks over several years. Its effects depend on its size and location; some can interfere with vision, breathing, feeding, or skin integrity.

Infantile Hepatic Hemangiomas

Benign growths made of extra blood vessels in an infant's liver. Small lesions may cause no symptoms, while numerous or large lesions can enlarge the liver, strain the heart, lower thyroid hormone, or cause bleeding problems. Ultrasound and specialist follow-up guide monitoring and treatment.

Infantile Myoclonic Encephalopathy

A severe early-life epileptic encephalopathy with recurrent myoclonic seizures and developmental impairment; diagnosis and classification require specialist neurologic evaluation.

Infantile Paralysis

Paralytic poliomyelitis caused by poliovirus infection involving motor neurons, which can produce acute flaccid paralysis and respiratory failure; vaccination prevents most cases.

Infantile Sleep Apnea

Repeated pauses in an infant's breathing during sleep. An event is generally defined as a pause lasting at least 20 seconds, or a shorter pause accompanied by a slowed heart rate, low oxygen, or a color change. Apnea may be central, with no breathing effort; obstructive, with effort but blocked airflow; or mixed. Brief pauses without these changes may be periodic breathing rather than apnea.

Infantile Spasm

Alternate singular form; see *Infantile Spasms*.

Infantile Spasms

A severe seizure disorder of infancy characterized by brief, sudden flexion or extension spasms, often occurring in clusters and associated with developmental impairment.

Infantile Spinal Muscular Atrophy

Spinal muscular atrophy beginning in infancy, causing progressive weakness from loss of motor neurons; see *Spinal Muscular Atrophy*.

Infantile Spinal Muscular Atrophy Type I

The severe infantile form of spinal muscular atrophy, usually beginning in the first months of life with marked weakness and low muscle tone; disease-modifying treatment and respiratory and nutritional support can affect outcomes.

Infant Incubators

Enclosed devices providing controlled warmth, humidity, oxygen, and monitoring for premature, small, or ill newborns who need extra support after birth.

Infant Jaundice

Yellowing of an infant's skin or eyes caused by excess bilirubin. It is often temporary, but jaundice in the

first day, rapid worsening, poor feeding, unusual sleepiness, or pale stools can occur with more serious disease.

Infant Leukemia

Infant leukemia is leukemia diagnosed during infancy, in which abnormal blood-forming cells multiply and interfere with normal blood-cell production.

Infant Mortality

The death of an infant before the first birthday; the infant mortality rate is usually expressed per 1,000 live births.

Infant Nutrition

Nutritional support for infants through breast milk, appropriately prepared formula, and developmentally suitable complementary foods. Requirements change with age, growth, illness, prematurity, and feeding ability; unsafe preparation can cause infection or malnutrition.

Infant Of Diabetic Mother

A newborn born to a mother with diabetes who may be at increased risk of large size, low blood sugar, breathing problems, jaundice, or congenital abnormalities.

Infant Reflex

An involuntary, stereotyped, subcortical motor response elicited by specific sensory stimuli in healthy neonates and infants, serving as an essential clinical indicator of central nervous system integrity and developmental progression. Key primitive reflexes include: the Moro reflex (sudden head extension elicits bilateral arm abduction and extension followed by flexion and cry; disappears by 4–6 months); the rooting and sucking reflexes (tactile perioral stimulation initiates head turning and suckling; integrated by 4 months); the palmar and plantar grasp reflexes (finger and toe flexion around an object; palmar fades by 4–6 months, plantar by 9–12 months); the asymmetric tonic neck reflex ("fencing posture"; disappears by 5–7 months); and the Babinski sign (extensor plantar response, normal up to 12–24 months due to incomplete corticospinal myelination). Persistence, asymmetry, or resurgence in adults (frontal release signs) signifies corticospinal tract lesion, diffuse encephalopathy, or neurodegenerative pathology.

Infant Reflexes

Plural form; see *Infant Reflex*.

Infant Reflux

Backflow of stomach contents into an infant's esophagus, often causing uncomplicated spitting up. It usually improves with age, but poor growth, breathing problems, blood, forceful vomiting, or distress can occur with more serious disease.

Infant Respiratory Distress Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Neonatal Respiratory Distress Syndrome*.

Infant Sleep Position

The position and sleep environment used for an infant. Placing infants on their backs on a firm, flat, nonshared surface without soft or loose bedding reduces the risk of sleep-related death.

Infant Test Procedure Preparation

Preparing a baby for a test may involve checking feeding or fasting instructions, bringing medicines and records, explaining the procedure to caregivers, and planning comfort, warmth, safe positioning, and monitoring afterward.

Infant With Prenatal Substance Exposure

A newborn exposed to alcohol or another substance during pregnancy who may need assessment for withdrawal, toxicity, feeding problems, or developmental effects.

Infarct

An area of dead tissue; see *Infarction*.

Infarction

Tissue death caused by inadequate blood flow and oxygen, usually because a vessel is blocked. Ex-

amples include heart attack, brain infarction, and intestinal infarction.

Infection

Entry and multiplication of bacteria, viruses, fungi, parasites, or other microorganisms in the body. Infection may cause tissue damage and illness, although some infections produce no symptoms; the cause and site determine treatment.

Infection Control

Practices that prevent microorganisms from spreading between people, objects, and healthcare settings. They include hand cleaning, appropriate protective equipment, safe injection and device care, cleaning, sterilization, vaccination, and isolation when needed.

Infection Imaging

A general term for using imaging to locate or assess a suspected infection; it does not name one specific test. Ultrasound or CT can show a collection such as an abscess, while MRI can assess suspected infection in bone, joints, or deep soft tissue. Images are interpreted with examination, laboratory, and microbiology results.

Infection Prevention

Measures that reduce the risk of infection, including hand hygiene, personal protective equipment, environmental cleaning, sterilization, disinfection, vaccination, and appropriate isolation precautions.

Infections in Diabetes

Infection in a person with diabetes, in whom hyperglycemia, vascular disease, neuropathy, or immune dysfunction may increase susceptibility or complicate healing. Assessment includes the source, severity, glycemic status, organ involvement, and need for source control.

Infections In Pregnancy

Infections during pregnancy can affect the pregnant person, placenta, fetus, or newborn. Some, including listeriosis, group B streptococcal infection, urinary infection, and sexually transmitted infections, can cause miscarriage, premature birth, fetal illness, or newborn sepsis. Testing and treatment depend on the organism and stage of pregnancy.

Infectious Arteritis

Inflammation and damage of an artery caused by infection, which can weaken the vessel, reduce blood flow, or produce aneurysm.

Infectious Arthritis

Inflammation of a joint caused by infection, usually bacterial and sometimes viral or fungal. Acute pain, swelling, warmth, fever, and restricted movement may occur, and joint damage can develop quickly.

Infectious Chorea

Chorea caused by an infection or post-infectious immune response, such as Sydenham chorea after group A streptococcal infection; see *Chorea*.

Infectious Colitis

Inflammation of the colon caused by an infection, usually from bacteria, viruses, or parasites. It can cause diarrhea, abdominal cramps, fever, or blood in the stool. The cause and severity vary with the organism and the person's health.

Infectious Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the conjunctiva caused by a virus, bacterium, or less commonly another infectious organism, often causing redness and discharge.

Infectious Disease

Illness caused by a pathogen such as a bacterium, virus, fungus, or parasite. Infection may spread between people, from animals or the environment, or from organisms normally living in the body.

Infectious Diseases

Alternate plural; see *Infectious Disease*.

Infectious Dose

The amount of a microorganism that must enter the body to cause infection under particular conditions. It varies with the organism, route of exposure, dose

strength, and the person's immune defenses.

Infectious Encephalitis

Brain inflammation caused by an infectious organism, most often a virus. It may cause fever, headache, confusion, seizures, behavior changes, weakness, or reduced consciousness.

Infectious Encephalomyelitis

Infection-related inflammation of the brain and spinal cord that may cause fever, headache, confusion, weakness, seizures, or other neurologic signs.

Infectious Enterocolitis

Infection-related inflammation of the small intestine and colon, commonly causing diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or vomiting.

Infectious Esophagitis

Infection and inflammation of the esophagus, most often caused by Candida yeast or herpes viruses in people with weakened immunity. It commonly causes painful or difficult swallowing and pain behind the breastbone.

Infectious Hepatitis

Alternate name; see *Viral Hepatitis*.

Infectious Mediastinitis

Infection and inflammation of the tissues in the middle of the chest, often after esophageal injury, surgery, or spread from a nearby infection.

Infectious Meningitis

Infection and inflammation of the membranes surrounding the brain and spinal cord. Bacterial meningitis may cause headache, fever, neck stiffness, vomiting, confusion, or a new rash.

Infectious Mononucleosis

A viral illness, usually caused by Epstein–Barr virus, that causes marked fatigue, sore throat, fever, and swollen lymph nodes. The spleen may enlarge during the illness.

Alternate Names:
Mono (Infectious Mononucleosis)

Infectious Myringitis

Inflammation and infection of the tympanic membrane, often associated with viral or bacterial respiratory infection. It can cause severe ear pain, fever, hearing reduction, and small fluid-filled blisters on the eardrum.

Infective Cervicitis

Infective cervicitis is inflammation of the cervix caused by organisms such as chlamydia, gonorrhea, trichomonas, or herpes, producing discharge, bleeding, or pelvic discomfort.

Infective Cystitis

Infective cystitis is bacterial or other microbial inflammation of the bladder, causing urinary frequency, urgency, burning, and sometimes blood or fever.

Infective Endocarditis

A serious infection of the inner lining of the heart's chambers and valves (the endocardium). It occurs when bacteria, fungi, or other microbes enter the bloodstream—often through dental procedures, skin infections, or intravenous needles—and settle on damaged, diseased, or artificial heart valves. The multiplying germs form infected clumps that can damage heart valves, disrupt blood flow, or break loose and travel to other organs.

Alternate Names:
Bacterial Endocarditis; Microbial Endocarditis; IE

Infective Endocarditis Duke Criteria

Clinical criteria used to classify suspected infective endocarditis as definite, possible, or rejected by combining major and minor findings. The 2023 Duke-ISCVID revision includes updated microbiological evidence and imaging from echocardiography, cardiac CT, and selected FDG-PET/CT studies, as well as operative findings. Criteria support diagnosis but are interpreted with the full clinical picture.

Alternate Names:
Duke Criteria for Infective Endocarditis; Modified Duke Criteria

Infective Endocarditis Pathology

Infection-associated vegetations composed of fibrin, platelets, inflammatory cells, necrotic debris, and microorganisms on a valve or endocardial surface. Destruction, abscesses, emboli, and healing fibrosis may occur.

Infective Phlebitis

Infective phlebitis is infection and inflammation of a vein, often around an intravenous catheter, causing pain, redness, swelling, and possible bloodstream infection.

Infective Vaginitis

Infective vaginitis is infection or inflammation of the vagina caused by yeast, bacteria, parasites, or viruses and may cause discharge, itching, odor, or pain.

Inferior

Below or nearer the feet compared with another body part. For example, the diaphragm is inferior to the heart, and the inferior vena cava carries blood from the lower part of the body to the heart.

Inferior Alveolar Nerve Block

A local-anesthetic injection near a nerve supplying the lower jaw. It temporarily numbs the lower teeth, jawbone, and lower lip on that side and is commonly used for dental procedures.

Inferior Colliculus

The inferior colliculus is a midbrain auditory relay that integrates sound information and helps orient reflexively to auditory stimuli.

Inferior Hemifield Loss

Loss of vision in the lower half of the area a person can see with one or both eyes. Causes include retinal disease, a stroke, or another problem along the brain's visual pathways; sudden loss can occur with serious disease.

Inferior Mediastinum

The part of the mediastinum below the level of the sternal angle. It is divided into the anterior, middle, and posterior mediastinum.

Inferior Mesenteric Artery

A major artery supplying the lower part of the large intestine, including the descending and sigmoid colon and upper rectum. Blockage or reduced flow can cause abdominal pain and ischemic colitis.

Inferior Myocardial Infarction

A heart attack affecting the lower surface of the heart muscle. It usually results from blocked blood flow in a coronary artery and can cause permanent damage.

Inferior Petrosal Sinus Sampling

A special blood test done through small catheters placed in veins near the pituitary gland. It compares hormone levels from the pituitary area with levels in a regular vein to help find the source of excess ACTH in suspected Cushing disease.

Alternate Names:
IPSS

Inferior Vena Cava

The body's largest vein, carrying blood from the legs, pelvis, abdomen, and liver to the right side of the heart. A clot or pressure on it can cause swelling of both legs and increase the risk of serious complications.

Inferior Vena Cava Filter

A small device placed in the inferior vena cava to catch clots traveling from the legs or pelvis to the lungs. It is used selectively, usually for acute venous thromboembolism when anticoagulation is contraindicated or has failed; complications include migration, vessel perforation, thrombosis, and difficulty removing retrievable filters.

Alternate Names:
IVC Filter; Inferior Vena Cava Filters; Greenfield Filter

Inferior Vena Cava Syndrome

A constellation of clinical symptoms caused by par-

tial or complete occlusion, thrombosis, or external tumor compression of the inferior vena cava, characterized by bilateral lower-extremity pitting edema, extensive superficial abdominal wall collateral vein dilation with cephalad blood flow, and dependent ascites.

Alternate Names:
IVC Obstruction; Caval Syndrome

Inferior Wall Myocardial Infarction

Ischemic myocardial necrosis localized to the inferior (diaphragmatic) aspect of the left ventricle, usually caused by acute thrombotic occlusion of the right coronary artery (RCA) or left circumflex artery, presenting with ST-segment elevation in leads II, III, and aVF, frequently associated with sinus bradycardia or AV block.

Alternate Names:
IWMI

Inferolateral

Located below and toward the side of a reference structure.

Infertility

Failure to achieve pregnancy after 12 months of regular unprotected intercourse, or sooner when age or medical history warrants evaluation. Causes may involve ovulation, sperm, reproductive organs, age, or unexplained factors.

Alternate Names:
Subfertility

Infestation

Presence of parasites such as lice, mites, or worms on or inside the body. The parasite may live on the skin or in an organ and can cause itching, inflammation, tissue injury, or other symptoms.

Infiltrate

A term with different uses in imaging and pathology. In chest imaging, it is an older, nonspecific label for an area of lung opacity; radiology reports now generally describe the opacity and its pattern instead. In pathology, an infiltrate is a collection of cells, such as inflammatory or tumor cells, within tissue.

Infiltrating Cancer

Cancer that has grown beyond its original location into nearby tissue. Such growth may damage normal structures and can allow cancer cells to enter lymph vessels or blood vessels and spread elsewhere.

Alternate Names:
Invasive cancer

Infiltrating Ductal Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Invasive Carcinoma Of No Special Type*.

Infiltration

Entry or accumulation of cells, fluid, or another substance within tissue. In clinical care, intravenous infiltration means leakage of nonvesicant fluid into surrounding tissue; extravasation of an irritant or vesicant can cause serious injury.

Inflamed Gallbladder

Alternate name; see *Cholecystitis*.

Inflamed Pancreas

Alternate name; see *Pancreatitis*.

Inflamed Pericardium

Alternate name; see *Pericarditis*.

Inflammaging

The gradual, low-level increase in inflammation that can occur with aging. It is influenced by chronic illness, immune-system changes, infections, and tissue damage and may contribute to frailty, artery disease, muscle loss, or brain disorders.

Inflammasomes

Groups of proteins inside immune cells that detect danger signals and activate inflammation. They help release inflammatory messenger proteins and can cause an infected or damaged cell to die. Excessive activation may contribute to autoimmune or inflammatory disease.

Inflammation

The body's protective response to injury, infection, or irritation. It may cause redness, warmth, swelling, pain, and reduced function. Short-term inflammation helps healing, while persistent inflammation can damage tissues and contribute to chronic disease.

Inflammation Imaging

Imaging used to find areas of active inflammation in the body. A scan using a sugar-like tracer may show infection or inflammation, but cancer can look similar; findings are considered alongside symptoms, examination, and other tests.

Inflammatory Back Pain

A pattern of chronic back pain characterized by insidious onset, improvement with exercise, lack of improvement with rest, nocturnal pain, and prolonged morning stiffness. It suggests axial spondyloarthritis but is not diagnostic without supportive clinical, laboratory, and imaging findings.

Inflammatory Bowel Disease

An umbrella term for chronic disorders that involve ongoing inflammation of the digestive tract. It primarily includes extbfCrohn's disease (which can cause patchy, deep-layer inflammation anywhere from the mouth to the anus) and extbfulcerative colitis (which causes continuous superficial inflammation and ulcers in the large intestine and rectum). Symptoms include recurring abdominal cramps, persistent diarrhea (often with blood), fatigue, and unexplained weight loss.

Alternate Names:
IBD

Inflammatory Bowel Disease/Crohn's Disease

Misleading combined label; inflammatory bowel disease includes Crohn disease and ulcerative colitis. See *Inflammatory Bowel Disease* and *Crohn Disease*.

Inflammatory Bowel Disease Diet

An eating plan adapted for Crohn disease or ulcerative colitis to maintain nutrition and reduce symptoms. During flares, temporary changes or liquid nutrition may help; food triggers vary, and restrictive diets can cause nutritional deficiencies.

Inflammatory Bowel Disease: Intestinal Problems

Alternate consumer label; see *Inflammatory Bowel Disease*.

Inflammatory Breast Cancer

A rare, fast-growing breast cancer in which cancer cells block lymph vessels in the skin of the breast, causing rapid redness, swelling, warmth, and thickened or dimpled skin. It often does not form a distinct lump.

Alternate Names:
IBC; Inflammatory Carcinoma of the Breast

Inflammatory Myopathies

A group of acquired muscle diseases in which immune-related inflammation or injury damages skeletal muscle. They commonly cause weakness, often around the hips and shoulders, but the pattern varies by type. Some forms also affect the skin, lungs, or muscles involved in swallowing. Types include dermatomyositis, inclusion body myositis, immune-mediated necrotizing myopathy, and overlap myositis.

Inflammatory Myopathy

A disorder in which immune or other inflammatory processes damage muscle, causing weakness and sometimes pain or involvement of the skin, lungs, swallowing muscles, or other organs.

Inflammatory Response

The body's organized reaction to infection, injury, or irritation. Blood flow changes and immune cells move into the affected area, causing signs such as redness, warmth, swelling, pain, or reduced function.

Infliximab

A biologic medicine that blocks tumor necrosis factor, an inflammatory signal. It treats several inflammatory diseases but can increase the risk of serious infections, tuberculosis reactivation, infusion reac-

tions, and heart-failure worsening.

Influenza

A contagious respiratory illness caused by influenza A or B viruses, characterized by sudden onset of fever, myalgia, headache, malaise, nonproductive cough, sore throat, and nasal congestion. Seasonal epidemics occur annually. Complications: pneumonia (primary viral or secondary bacterial), exacerbation of underlying conditions.

Influenza A Virus

An influenza virus with segmented RNA that infects people and animals and can cause seasonal epidemics or, after major genetic changes, pandemics.

Influenza Test

A test for influenza A or B using a respiratory specimen. Rapid antigen tests provide quick results but may miss infection. Molecular tests are generally more sensitive and may identify or subtype influenza viruses; results vary with symptoms, timing, and laboratory methods.

Influenza Vaccination In Pregnancy

Influenza vaccination during pregnancy protects the pregnant person from severe flu and can provide some protection to the newborn. Inactivated or recombinant vaccines are used; live attenuated nasal-spray vaccine is not used during pregnancy.

Influenza Virus

A segmented, negative-sense RNA virus belonging to the Orthomyxoviridae family. Influenza causes seasonal epidemics and occasional pandemics of respiratory illness. The virus has two surface glycoproteins: hemagglutinin (HA), which mediates attachment, and neuraminidase (NA), which facilitates release.

Influenzavirus A

A group of influenza A viruses that infect people and animals. They are classified into subtypes according to two surface proteins and can cause seasonal outbreaks, severe illness, or pandemics.

Influenzavirus B

Influenza B virus, an enveloped, segmented, negative-sense RNA virus in the family Orthomyxoviridae and genus Betainfluenzavirus. It primarily infects humans and causes seasonal respiratory illness. Unlike influenza A viruses, influenza B viruses are not classified into H and N subtypes; they are grouped into lineages.

Informatics

Informatics applies information science, data, computing, and human factors to organize and improve healthcare, biology, research, or another field.

Informed Consent

A patient's voluntary agreement to a proposed intervention after receiving understandable information about its purpose, benefits, risks, alternatives, and the option of declining, with decision-making capacity or appropriate authorization.

Infrared Rays

Infrared rays are electromagnetic radiation with wavelengths longer than visible red light; excessive exposure can heat tissue and cause burns.

Infrared Spectrometry

A method for identifying or measuring substances by examining how they absorb infrared light. Different chemical bonds absorb different wavelengths, creating a pattern that can help analyze medicines, tissues, samples, or pollutants.

Infrared Therapy

Treatment using infrared radiation, usually to provide heat or light to tissues. It is used in some physiotherapy and skin treatments, but benefits vary and excessive exposure can cause burns or eye injury.

Infrarenal Aorta

The infrarenal aorta is the portion of the abdominal aorta below the renal arteries and above its division into the iliac arteries.

Infraspinatus Muscle

A thick, triangular rotator cuff muscle originating from the infraspinous fossa of the scapula and inserting onto the middle facet of the greater tubercle of the humerus, innervated by the suprascapular nerve; acts primarily as the chief external (lateral) rotator of the glenohumeral joint.

Infratentorial Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the lower part of the skull, near the cerebellum and brainstem. Its effects depend on size and location and may include headache, vomiting, balance problems, weakness, or changes in coordination.

Infrequent

Infrequent means occurring less often than usual or expected, such as infrequent bowel movements, symptoms, or events.

Infundibular Stenosis

Subvalvular muscular narrowing or hypertrophy of the right ventricular outflow tract below the pulmonary valve, classically forming the dynamic subpulmonary obstruction component in tetralogy of Fallot or isolated subpulmonic stenosis.

Infundibulopelvic Ligament

A peritoneal fold extending from the lateral pelvic wall to the superior pole of the ovary that conveys the ovarian artery, ovarian vein, lymphatic channels, and ovarian nerve plexus, serving as a critical surgical landmark during salpingo-oophorectomy.

Alternate Names:
Suspensory Ligament of the Ovary; IP Ligament

Infundibulum

A funnel-shaped anatomical structure or passage, specifically referring to the hollow neural stalk connecting the hypothalamic median eminence to the posterior pituitary gland (hypophysis), or the funnel-shaped distal expansion of the fallopian tube.

Alternate Names:
Pituitary Stalk; Funnel-Shaped Anatomical Passage

Infuse

To introduce a fluid, medicine, or other substance gradually into the body, commonly through an intravenous line; it can also mean to soak a substance in a liquid.

Infusion

The controlled introduction of a fluid or medicine into the body over time, commonly through a vein but also by other routes such as subcutaneous or intrathecal delivery. The route, rate, and duration depend on the substance and purpose. An infusion differs from a single bolus injection by delivering material gradually.

Infusion Pump

A medical device that delivers a measured amount of fluid or medicine at a controlled rate. Depending on its design, it may deliver material intravenously, subcutaneously, or intrathecally. Common types include volumetric infusion pumps and syringe pumps; alarms may indicate occlusion, air, low battery, or other device conditions.

Alternate Names:
IV Infusion Pump

Ingested Foreign Body

An object accidentally or intentionally swallowed that lodges in the esophagus, stomach, or intestines, such as coins, small toys, button batteries, or sharp objects requiring clinical assessment and possible endoscopic retrieval.

Alternate Names:
Swallowed Foreign Object; Foreign Body Ingestion; Gastrointestinal Foreign Body

Ingestion

The act of taking a substance into the digestive tract by swallowing. Ingestion of a toxic substance can cause poisoning.

Ingredient

An ingredient is a substance included in a medicine, food, cosmetic, or other preparation, whether active or inactive.

Ingrown Hair

A hair that curls back into or grows sideways beneath the skin, causing an itchy or painful bump. It may become inflamed or infected, especially after shaving, waxing, or close trimming.

Ingrown Nail

An ingrown nail occurs when the nail edge grows into surrounding skin, causing pain, redness, swelling, and sometimes infection or granulation tissue.

Ingrown Nail (Onychocryptosis)

Alternate name; see *Ingrown Nail*.

Alternate Names:
Onychocryptosis; Ingrown Toenail

Ingrown Toenail (Onychocryptosis)

An ingrown nail affecting a toe, usually the great toe, in which the nail edge penetrates the lateral nail fold. Persistent pain, pus, spreading redness, or recurrent disease may require clinician treatment or partial nail removal.

Ingrown Toenails

A condition in which the edge of a toenail grows into nearby skin, most often on the big toe. It causes pain, redness, and swelling; infection, diabetes, or severe symptoms may complicate it.

Inguinal

Relating to the groin, the region where the lower abdomen meets the upper thigh and where certain hernias, lymph nodes, and injuries occur.

Inguinal Canal

A short passage through the lower abdominal wall near the groin. It carries the spermatic cord in males and the uterine round ligament in females; weakness here can allow an inguinal hernia.

Inguinal Hernia

A bulge formed when fat or intestine pushes through a weak area in the groin. It may cause discomfort or a lump that appears with standing or straining; severe pain, vomiting, or a trapped lump may indicate reduced blood flow or bowel blockage.

Inguinal Hernia Repair

Surgery that returns tissue to the abdomen and closes or strengthens a weak area in the groin. It may be performed through a larger incision or several small ones, with or without mesh; recurrence, infection, and persistent pain are possible.

Inguinal Orchiectomy

Inguinal orchiectomy is removal of a testicle through an incision in the groin, commonly used when treating suspected testicular cancer.

Inguinal Region

The groin area where the lower abdomen meets the upper thigh. It contains important muscles, blood vessels, nerves, and lymph nodes and is a common site for hernias and some injuries.

Inhalant

A substance breathed into the lungs as a gas, vapor, aerosol, or smoke; inhalants may be medicines, workplace substances, or abused chemicals.

Inhalant Substance Use

Inhalant misuse involves breathing fumes or gases from household or industrial products and can cause sudden cardiac arrest, brain injury, organ damage, dependence, or death.

Inhalation

Drawing air, medicine, particles, or vapors into the lungs. Inhalation is a route for respiratory medicines and anesthetics, while accidental inhalation of food, vomit, smoke, or toxic substances can cause airway obstruction or lung injury.

Inhalational Anesthesia

General anesthesia given by breathing an anesthetic gas or vapor through a mask or breathing tube. The amount reaching the bloodstream controls unconsciousness and is adjusted while breathing, circulation, and other vital signs are monitored.

Inhalation Injury

Damage to the airway or lungs from smoke, hot gases, or toxic chemicals. Swelling, cough, wheezing, low oxygen, and poisoning by carbon monoxide or cyanide may develop or worsen over several hours after a fire.

Inhaled Corticosteroids

Anti-inflammatory medicines breathed into the airways to reduce swelling and prevent asthma symptoms. They are usually used regularly for control; some combination inhalers containing a fast-acting medicine may also be prescribed for symptom relief. Side effects can include hoarseness or oral thrush.

Inhaled Foreign Body

An object or food particle entering the larynx, trachea, or bronchial tree. It may cause choking, coughing, wheezing, stridor, or airway obstruction; removal may require bronchoscopy.

Alternate Names:
Airway Foreign Body; Foreign Body Aspiration; Tracheobronchial Foreign Body

Inhaled Nitric Oxide

A gas given through a breathing system to widen blood vessels in the lungs and sometimes improve oxygen levels. It is used short term in selected critical illnesses and requires continuous delivery and monitoring for blood-salt or oxygen-related effects.

Inhaler

A device that delivers medicine into the airways through the mouth. Pressurised inhalers release a measured spray, while dry-powder inhalers release powder during a strong breath in; technique affects the amount of medicine reaching the lungs.

Inherited Disease

A disease caused wholly or partly by a genetic change inherited from a parent or present in reproductive cells and therefore capable of being passed to offspring. Some disease-causing changes arise de novo in an egg, sperm, or early embryo rather than being inherited from a parent.

Inherited Lipodystrophy

A genetic disorder causing partial or generalized loss or abnormal distribution of body fat, often with severe insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, and fatty liver; see *Lipodystrophy*.

Inhibin

A glycoprotein hormone produced mainly by the gonads that suppresses pituitary follicle-stimulating hormone secretion and contributes to regulation of reproductive function.

Inhibition

Inhibition is a reduction or suppression of an activity, such as nerve signalling, enzyme action, muscle contraction, or cell growth.

Inhibitory Neurochemical

A chemical messenger that decreases the activity of nerve cells or muscles. Gamma-aminobutyric acid and glycine are important inhibitory neurotransmitters in the nervous system.

Alternate Names:
Inhibitory neurotransmitter

Inhibitory Synapse

A connection between nerve cells that reduces the chance that the receiving cell will generate an electrical signal.

Iniencephaly

A rare, usually lethal neural-tube defect characterized by occipital bone defect, severe retroflexion of the head, and marked shortening or distortion of the cervical and thoracic spine. It is often identified prenatally and may occur with other congenital anomalies.

Initial Insomnia

Initial insomnia is difficulty falling asleep at the beginning of the sleep period, often related to stress, habits, medicines, mood, or another sleep disorder.

Injectable Fillers

Materials placed under or within the skin to re-

store volume, improve contours, or soften wrinkles. Effects vary by product and may include swelling, bruising, infection, lumps, or rare blood-vessel blockage.

Alternate Names:
Dermal fillers

Injection

Introduction of a medication, fluid, or other substance into the body with a needle or other injection device.

Injection Drug Use

Use of medicines or illicit substances by injection. Risks include overdose, blood-borne infection, skin and vascular injury, endocarditis, abscesses, and transmission through shared equipment.

Injury

Damage to the body's tissues or function caused by trauma, force, heat, chemicals, radiation, or another harmful exposure.

Injury Dating

Estimation of the age of an injury using clinical appearance, histopathology, imaging, and the history of symptoms. Exact dating is often uncertain, particularly for bruises and soft-tissue injuries, which limits the precision of conclusions.

Injury Site

The body location where physical harm occurred or where its effects are being examined, documented, treated, and monitored during recovery.

Ink Poisoning

Illness after swallowing or significant exposure to ink; most small pen-ink exposures cause little toxicity, but symptoms depend on the product and amount.

Ink Remover Poisoning

Poisoning caused by chemicals used to remove ink, which may irritate the skin, eyes, lungs, or digestive tract and may cause systemic toxicity.

Innate Immune Evasion

Mechanisms by which pathogens evade the innate immune system. Strategies include capsules that prevent phagocytosis, biofilms that protect against immune cells, and intracellular survival within macrophages. Some bacteria produce enzymes that degrade complement components. Others modify their surface molecules to avoid recognition.

Innate Immunity

The body's rapid defense against germs and tissue damage, present from birth. It includes skin, mucus, inflammation, cells that engulf germs, and protective proteins and usually responds within minutes or hours.

Innate Lymphoid Cells

Immune cells that respond quickly to tissue damage or infection without recognizing one specific antigen. Different groups help control viruses, parasites, bacteria, fungi, allergic inflammation, and tissue repair.

Inner Ear

The deepest part of the ear, containing the cochlea for hearing and balance organs for movement sensing. Disease there can cause hearing loss, ringing, dizziness, or balance problems.

Inner Ear Infection

Inner-ear inflammation can affect hearing and balance, producing vertigo, nausea, tinnitus, or hearing loss. Causes include viral infection, bacterial disease, autoimmune inflammation, or other disorders; sudden hearing loss, severe imbalance, or neurologic signs may occur.

Innervation

The nerve supply to an organ, muscle, or area of the body, including the functional control provided by those nerves.

Innominate

An older anatomical adjective meaning unnamed, used in the names of particular structures. The innominate artery is the brachiocephalic artery, and

the innominate bone is the hip bone, also called the coxal bone.

INOCA

Ischemia with non-obstructive coronary arteries: objective myocardial ischemia or ischemic symptoms in a patient whose coronary arteries do not have an obstructive epicardial stenosis. Mechanisms include coronary microvascular dysfunction and vasospastic angina; treatment varies with the underlying mechanism.

Inoculation

Introduction of microorganisms, cells, or other material into a culture, living body, or normally sterile site. It may be deliberate for laboratory growth, vaccination, or treatment, or accidental and capable of causing infection.

Inoperable

Not safely treatable by surgery, often because a disease is too extensive, located near vital structures, or the person is too medically fragile. Other treatments may still be possible.

Inorganic

Not based mainly on carbon-containing molecular structures. Inorganic substances include water, salts, minerals, and metals, many of which are essential to body function while others can be toxic.

Inorganic Chemical

A chemical compound that is generally not based on carbon chains, such as water, salts, minerals, or metals. In the body, inorganic substances support fluid balance, nerve signals, bone structure, and many chemical reactions.

Inosculation

The joining and establishment of a connection between blood vessels or vascularized tissues, important in wound healing, grafts, flaps, and transplantation.

Inosine

A nucleoside made of hypoxanthine linked to ribose that participates in purine metabolism and cellular energy pathways.

Inosine Monophosphate

A nucleotide containing inosine and one phosphate group; it is an intermediate in purine metabolism and a precursor of other nucleotides.

Inosine Pranobex

A medicine combination marketed in some countries as an immunomodulator or antiviral; evidence and approved uses vary by jurisdiction.

Inositol

A sugar-like compound involved in cell membranes and signaling; some forms are studied or used for selected metabolic, reproductive, or mental-health conditions.

Inositol 1,4,5-Trisphosphate

A second messenger molecule generated when phospholipase C cleaves membrane phosphatidylinositol 4,5-bisphosphate (PIP2). It binds calcium-release channels on the endoplasmic reticulum and mobilizes intracellular calcium stores.

Alternate Names:
IP3; Ins(1,4,5)P3; Inositol Trisphosphate

Inositol Phosphates

Phosphorylated forms of inositol that act in cell signaling, calcium regulation, and other intracellular processes.

Inotropes In Anesthesia

Medicines used during anesthesia or critical illness to increase the force of heart contraction and support blood flow when the heart is failing. They are given by controlled infusion and require monitoring because they can cause abnormal heart rhythms, low or high blood pressure, and increased oxygen demand.

Inotropic

Affecting the force of cardiac muscle contraction; a positive inotropic drug increases contractility, while a negative inotropic effect decreases it.

Inotropic Agent

A pharmacologic agent that modifies myocardial contractility. Positive inotropes (e.g., dobutamine, milrinone, digoxin, dopamine, epinephrine) enhance the force of myocardial contraction to augment cardiac output in decompensated heart failure or cardiogenic shock, while negative inotropes (e.g., beta-blockers, non-dihydropyridine calcium channel blockers) diminish contractile force, reducing myocardial work and oxygen consumption. See also *Inotrope*.

Alternate Names:
Inotropes; Inotropic Drugs

Inpatient

An inpatient is a person admitted to a healthcare facility for monitoring, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, or care requiring an overnight or formal stay.

Inpatient Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided while a person stays in a hospital or specialized facility. It combines physical, occupational, speech, nursing, and medical care to restore function after problems such as stroke, brain injury, spinal injury, or major illness.

INR

A standardized blood-test result showing how quickly blood clots. It is used mainly to adjust warfarin and similar medicines; the desired range depends on why the medicine is prescribed, and too high or too low a result can be dangerous.

Insecta

The biological class containing insects. Some insects bite or sting, cause allergic reactions, contaminate food, or spread infections and parasites; medical importance depends on the species and exposure.

Insect Bite

A localized mechanical, chemical, or immunological cutaneous lesion resulting from the puncture or injection of venom or saliva by an arthropod (e.g., mosquitoes, fleas, bedbugs, biting flies, lice). Arthropod saliva contains anticoagulants, vasodilators, and foreign protein antigens that trigger histamine- and IgE- or T-cell-mediated hypersensitivity reactions, presenting clinically as intensely pruritic, erythematous papules, urticarial wheals, or central puncta. Secondary complications include excoriation with bacterial superinfection (impetigo, cellulitis), systemic hypersensitivity (anaphylaxis from hymenoptera stings), and the transmission of vector-borne pathogens (such as malaria, dengue, West Nile virus, Lyme disease, and leishmaniasis). Treatment focuses on antipruritics, topical corticosteroids, antihistamines, and systemic epinephrine for anaphylaxis.

Insect Bites

Plural form; see *Insect Bite*.

Insect Bites And Stings

Bites and stings from insects such as mosquitoes, fleas, bedbugs, bees, wasps, hornets, yellow jackets, and ants can cause local pain, itching, swelling, allergic reactions, infection, or toxin effects; breathing difficulty or widespread symptoms may occur with a severe reaction.

Insecticide

A chemical or biological agent used to kill or control insects. Exposure can cause skin, eye, respiratory, neurologic, or cholinergic toxicity depending on the product; prevention and treatment require identifying the active ingredient.

Insecticide Poisoning

Poisoning whose presentation depends on the active ingredient. Organophosphates and carbamates cause cholinergic excess with secretions, miosis, bronchospasm, fasciculations, and weakness; pyrethroids can cause paresthesias, tremor, or seizures; other products have different toxicities. Identify the product and treat the agent-specific

syndrome.

Insect Sting Allergies

Immune reactions to venom from insects such as bees, wasps, hornets, and fire ants. Reactions may be local or systemic; generalized hives, breathing difficulty, dizziness, vomiting, or throat swelling may indicate anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Hymenoptera Venom Allergy; Insect Venom Allergy

Insect Virus

A virus that infects insects or other arthropods; some are studied for ecology or biological pest control rather than human disease.

Insemination

Introduction of sperm into the female reproductive tract, either through intercourse or an assisted-reproduction procedure such as intrauterine insemination. Indications, success rates, infection screening, and risks depend on the method and patient factors.

Insensible Fluid Loss

Obligatory water loss from the body that occurs continuously and imperceptibly through evaporation from the respiratory tract (exhaled vapor) and diffusion through the skin (transdermal evaporation without sweating), normally accounting for approximately 600 to 800 mL of fluid loss per day in adults.

Insertion

Movement of a muscle attachment toward its fixed attachment, or placement of one structure into another.

Insidious

Developing slowly and quietly, often without obvious early symptoms. An insidious illness may be present for a long time before it is recognized, so the term describes its gradual pattern rather than its cause or severity.

Insinuate

To introduce or insert gradually into a space, or to suggest something indirectly; in anatomy, a structure may insinuate between or around other structures.

In Situ

In its original place. In pathology, carcinoma in situ consists of abnormal or cancer-like cells that remain within the surface layer and have not invaded deeper tissue. It has not spread through blood or lymph vessels, but some lesions can become invasive if untreated.

Alternate Names:
In place

In Situ Carcinoma

Abnormal cells that remain within the tissue layer where they began and have not grown into deeper tissue or nearby blood or lymph vessels. Some can become invasive if untreated.

In Situ Hybridization

A laboratory test that uses marked probes to find a specific DNA or RNA sequence inside cells or tissue. It can detect some gene changes, viruses, or where a gene is active.

Insomnia

Difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early despite adequate opportunity and suitable conditions for sleep. It may be short-term or persistent. Daytime effects can include fatigue, poor concentration, or irritability. Persistent symptoms that cause significant distress or impaired functioning may meet criteria for insomnia disorder.

Alternate Names:
Sleeplessness

Insomnia Disorder

Difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or returning to sleep after waking too early, despite adequate opportunity for sleep, at least three nights per week for at least three months. The sleep difficulty causes significant distress or impairment in daytime, social, occupational, educational, or other important

functioning.

Inspection

Systematic visual examination of a person or specimen for abnormalities such as changes in color, swelling, deformity, skin lesions, unusual movement, discharge, breathing effort, or overall appearance.

Inspiratory Capacity

Inspiratory capacity is the maximum volume inhaled after a normal exhalation and equals tidal volume plus inspiratory reserve volume.

Inspiratory Crackles

Brief clicking or popping sounds heard while breathing in. They may occur when small airways or air sacs open and can be caused by fluid, infection, scarring, lung collapse, or heart failure; the sound alone does not identify the cause.

Inspiratory Reserve Volume

The maximum additional volume of gas that can be voluntarily and forcefully inhaled into the lungs at the end of a normal, quiet tidal inspiration, typically measuring approximately 2.5 to 3.0 liters in healthy adults.

Alternate Names:
IRV

Inspiratory Time

The length of time spent breathing in during a natural breath or mechanical-ventilation cycle. Adjusting it can affect airflow, oxygen delivery, comfort, pressure, and the balance between inhaling and exhaling.

Inspiratory-to-Expiratory Ratio

The proportion of time spent breathing in compared with breathing out. The ratio varies with a person's breathing pattern and ventilator settings; a longer time to breathe out may be used in obstructive lung disease to reduce air trapping.

Alternate Names:
I:E Ratio

Inspissation

Thickening of a fluid or secretion as water is lost, leaving dense, concentrated material. In tissue samples, inspissated secretions may appear as dense material within ducts or glands.

Instantaneous Wave-Free Ratio

A measurement made during heart catheterization to judge whether a narrowed heart artery limits blood flow. A pressure wire compares pressure beyond and before the narrowing while the heart is relaxed. A result of 0.89 or less may support treatment when it fits the symptoms and other findings.

Alternate Names:
iFR; Wave-Free Ratio; Resting Coronary Physiology

Instillation

Slow placement of a liquid medicine or solution into a body cavity, organ, wound, or tissue, such as eye drops, bladder treatment, or fluid placed into a surgical space.

Instrument

A tool or device used by healthcare workers for examination, measurement, diagnosis, surgery, treatment, patient care, or laboratory work.

Instrumental Activities Of Daily Living

Everyday tasks needed for independent living outside basic self-care, including preparing food, shopping, managing medicines and money, using transportation, communicating, and maintaining a home. Difficulty with these tasks may signal functional decline.

Instrumental ADL

A complex activity needed for independent community living, such as shopping, cooking, managing medicines or finances, and using transportation.

Instrument Sterilization

A validated process that destroys all forms of microbial life, including bacterial spores, on or within a medical instrument. Common methods include steam under pressure, ethylene oxide, hydrogen-

peroxide plasma, and dry heat, selected according to device material and design.

Insufficient Cervix

Painless shortening and opening of the cervix during pregnancy, usually in the second trimester, without labor contractions. It can cause pregnancy loss or early birth and may require close monitoring or treatment.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Insufficiency; Cervical Incompetence

Insula

The insula is a cerebral cortical region involved in sensation, taste, emotion, interoception, pain, and integration of internal and external information.

Insular Cortex

A pyramid-shaped cortical region situated deep within the lateral sulcus (Sylvian fissure), covered by the frontal, parietal, and temporal opercula, which coordinates interoceptive sensory awareness, visceral autonomic functions, pain perception, gustation, and emotional empathy.

Alternate Names:
Insula; Island of Reil

Insulin

A hormone made by the pancreas that helps cells use glucose and lowers blood sugar. It is used to treat diabetes, but too much can cause dangerously low blood sugar with sweating, confusion, seizures, or unconsciousness.

Insulin Antagonist

A hormone, medicine, or other factor that opposes insulin's effects and can raise blood glucose.

Insulin Aspart

A rapid-acting insulin analog (modified amino acid sequence) with onset 10-20 minutes, peak 1-3 hours, duration 3-5 hours. Used to cover prandial glucose (injected at or just after meals) in type 1 and type 2 diabetes; also used in continuous subcutaneous insulin infusion (pump) and IV in acute settings.

Insulin Autoantibodies

Antibodies directed against insulin. They may be measured when assessing autoimmune diabetes or unexplained changes in blood glucose; antibodies to other beta-cell targets, such as GAD, IA-2, and ZnT8, are separate tests.

Insulin Coma

A state of severe hypoglycemia and unconsciousness caused by excessive insulin; it is a medical emergency and is not a current routine treatment.

Insulin C-Peptide Test

A blood or urine test measuring C-peptide released in equal amounts with endogenous insulin; it helps distinguish native insulin production from injected insulin and evaluate hypoglycemia or diabetes classification.

Insulin-Dependent Diabetes

Older term, usually referring to type 1 diabetes; see *Type 1 Diabetes*.

Insulin Detemir

A long-acting insulin analogue used to provide basal insulin replacement in diabetes mellitus; dosing is individualized and hypoglycemia is the principal serious adverse effect.

Insulin Glargine

A long-acting insulin used to provide background glucose control in diabetes. It is available in several formulations whose duration and dosing schedules differ; it is usually combined with mealtime insulin in type 1 diabetes.

Insulin-Induced Lipohypertrophy

A common complication of subcutaneous insulin therapy characterized by localized accumulation of adipose tissue at injection sites, caused by the lipogenic effect of insulin on subcutaneous fat. It presents as firm, rubbery, non-tender subcutaneous nodules that can cause unpredictable insulin absorption and glycemic variability.

Insulin Injection Technique

The method of injecting insulin into the fatty tissue under the skin. Common sites include the abdomen, thighs, buttocks, and upper arms; repeated injections in one place can cause fatty thickening and variable absorption.

Insulin Isophane

Intermediate-acting human insulin, also called neutral protamine Hagedorn insulin, used for basal glucose control in diabetes mellitus.

Insulin-Like Growth Factor

A hormone, mainly IGF-1, made largely by the liver in response to growth hormone. It supports growth of bone and other tissues and helps regulate metabolism. Abnormally high or low levels can occur with pituitary, liver, nutritional, or chronic illnesses.

Insulin-Like Growth Factor 1

A 70-amino-acid peptide hormone synthesized primarily by hepatocytes under the transcriptional stimulation of growth hormone (GH), which mediates the systemic anabolic, mitogenic, and linear skeletal growth effects of GH; serves as the primary screening biomarker for acromegaly and gigantism.

Alternate Names:
IGF-1; Somatomedin C

Insulin Lipohypertrophy

Thickened, rubbery fatty tissue that develops where insulin is injected repeatedly. Insulin absorbed from these areas may act unpredictably, so rotating injection sites helps prevent the problem and improves glucose control.

Insulin Lispro

A rapid-acting insulin analogue used around meals or for correction of high blood glucose in diabetes mellitus.

Insulinoma

An insulinoma is a usually benign pancreatic beta-cell neuroendocrine tumour that secretes excessive insulin, causing recurrent fasting or exertional hypoglycaemia relieved by glucose.

Insulin Pen Devices

Pre-filled or refillable devices that deliver measured insulin through a small needle under the skin. They are portable; dose, injection technique, storage, and needle disposal vary by device and prescription.

Insulin Preparations

Forms of insulin used to lower blood glucose by helping body cells take up glucose and reducing glucose release by the liver. They differ in onset and duration, and the type and dose vary by treatment plan.

Alternate Names:
Insulins; Insulin Medicines

Insulin Pumps

Insulin pumps deliver rapid-acting insulin continuously and through programmed meal or correction doses, allowing flexible management of diabetes while requiring monitoring and device safety.

Insulin Pump Therapy

Delivery of rapid-acting insulin through a small tube under the skin. The pump gives a continuous background dose and extra doses around meals or to correct high blood glucose. Users need training, monitoring, and a backup plan if the device fails.

Insulin Receptor

A protein on the surface of many cells that binds insulin and sends signals allowing cells to take up and use glucose. It also influences fat, protein, and cell-growth processes.

Insulin Resistance

A state in which muscle, fat, and liver cells respond poorly to insulin. The pancreas may produce extra insulin at first, but blood glucose can eventually rise, increasing the risk of type 2 diabetes and metabolic syndrome.

Alternate Names:
IR (Insulin Resistance)

Insulin Resistance Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Metabolic Syndrome*.

Insulin Resistance Syndromes

Rare inherited disorders in which the body responds poorly to insulin, sometimes because of a change in the insulin receptor. Severe forms can cause very high insulin levels, abnormal growth, diabetes, unusual body features, and serious illness early in life.

Insulin Secretion

Release of insulin from pancreatic beta cells in response primarily to increased plasma glucose, with amplification by incretin hormones and nutrients. Insulin promotes glucose uptake, glycogen synthesis, lipogenesis, and protein synthesis while suppressing hepatic glucose production.

Insulin Signaling

The cellular process initiated when insulin binds its receptor and activates pathways that regulate glucose uptake, glycogen formation, protein synthesis, and fat metabolism.

Insulin Storage and Syringe Safety

Storage and handling of insulin and injection equipment. Unopened insulin is commonly refrigerated, but temperature limits and the time a product can be used after opening vary by insulin, pen, vial, and pump. Freezing or excessive heat can damage insulin; needles and syringes are generally single-use and placed in an approved sharps container.

Alternate Names:
Insulin Administration Safety; Diabetes Sharps Disposal

Insulin Therapy in Diabetes

Treatment with subcutaneous injections or continuous pump infusions of insulin to control blood glucose levels in type 1 diabetes, advanced type 2 diabetes, or gestational diabetes.

Alternate Names:
Insulin Administration; Exogenous Insulin Therapy; Diabetes Insulin Management

Insulin Tolerance Test

A specialist test in which insulin is given through a vein to lower blood sugar under close supervision. It measures how the body releases stress hormones such as cortisol and growth hormone. Because very low blood sugar can be dangerous, the test requires careful monitoring.

Alternate Names:
ITT; Insulin-Induced Hypoglycemia Test

Integrase

Integrase is an enzyme that inserts viral DNA into a host genome, a process targeted by integrase inhibitors used in HIV treatment.

Integrative Medicine

Patient-centered care that combines evidence-based conventional treatment with appropriate complementary approaches, emphasizing whole-person health, prevention, lifestyle, and shared decision-making.

Integrative Rehabilitation

A rehabilitation plan that combines standard physical, occupational, or speech therapy with selected complementary approaches, such as relaxation or mindfulness, when they are safe and supported by evidence.

Integrin

A cell-surface receptor that links cells to the extracellular matrix and helps control adhesion, movement, signaling, and immune-cell activity.

Integrin Binding

The attachment of a molecule or cell to an integrin receptor, which can influence adhesion, migration, signaling, or clot formation.

Integron

A genetic element containing an integrase and an attachment site that can capture and express gene cassettes; integrons commonly contribute to bacterial antimicrobial resistance.

Integrons

Alternate plural; see *Integron*.

Integumentary System

The body system comprising the skin and its appendages: hair, nails, sweat glands, and sebaceous glands. It forms a protective barrier, limits fluid loss, contributes to thermoregulation and sensation, supports immune defence, and participates in vitamin D synthesis.

Intein

An intein is a protein segment that excises itself from a precursor protein while joining the surrounding extein sequences.

Intellectual Developmental Disorder

A neurodevelopmental condition characterized by significant limitations in general intellectual functioning and adaptive behavior during the developmental period; the formal clinical term for intellectual disability. See *Intellectual Disability*.

Intellectual Disability

A developmental condition involving significant difficulty with learning, reasoning, communication, and everyday independent skills. It begins during childhood and varies widely in severity; support needs depend on the person's abilities and environment.

Intelligence

Intelligence is the capacity to learn, reason, solve problems, understand information, and adapt; tests measure selected abilities rather than a person's entire worth or potential.

Intelligence Test

An intelligence test uses standardized tasks to estimate cognitive abilities such as reasoning, memory, language, and problem-solving.

Intense Pulsed Light

A treatment using brief pulses of broad-spectrum light for selected skin conditions and hair reduction. Light is absorbed by pigment or blood vessels, and treatment can cause temporary redness, burns, pigment changes, or eye injury.

Alternate Names:
IPL

Intensity

The degree of effort or physiological demand during physical activity.

Intensity-Modulated Radiation Therapy

A type of radiation treatment that varies the strength of many small radiation beams to match the shape of a tumor. It aims to treat the tumor while reducing radiation to nearby healthy tissue.

Intensive Care

Specialized treatment for people who are seriously ill or at risk of organ failure. It provides continuous monitoring, medicines, procedures, and life support such as a ventilator when needed.

Intensive Care Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation begun during or soon after intensive care to reduce weakness and loss of function. It may include safe positioning, movement, breathing exercises, and help with communication or daily activities.

Intensive Care Unit

A hospital unit for people who are critically ill or at high risk of organ failure. Staff provide continuous monitoring, urgent treatments, and support such as a ventilator, dialysis, or medicines to maintain blood pressure.

Intentional Obstetrical Clavicle Fracture

A deliberate fracture of a baby's collarbone during an emergency delivery when the shoulders are stuck and other measures have failed. It creates more room for birth and usually heals, but is used only as a last-resort obstetric procedure.

Alternate Names:
Cleidotomy; Obstetric Clavicular Fracture

Intention Tremor

A tremor that becomes more pronounced during a purposeful movement toward a target. It commonly suggests cerebellar or cerebellar-pathway dysfunction, although medicines, toxins, and other neurologic disorders can contribute.

Interatrial Septum

The wall between the heart's right and left upper chambers. It includes the fossa ovalis, a normal remnant of fetal circulation, and contains a thinner area that may be crossed during selected catheter procedures.

Intercalated Disc

An intercalated disc is a specialized junction connecting cardiac muscle cells and transmitting electrical and mechanical force through the heart.

Intercalating Agent

An intercalating agent inserts between DNA base pairs and can disrupt replication or transcription; some are laboratory reagents or anticancer drugs.

Intercellular

Located between cells or occurring in the space between cells. Intercellular material and signals help cells attach, communicate, exchange substances, and organize tissues throughout the body.

Intercostal

Intercostal means located between the ribs, especially the muscles, nerves, and blood vessels in those spaces.

Intercostal Muscles

Muscles between the ribs that help expand and compress the chest during breathing and also assist movement of the trunk.

Intercostal Retraction

Inward movement of the skin and soft tissues between the ribs during inspiration, indicating increased work of breathing. It is common in infants and children with respiratory distress and may accompany airway obstruction, bronchiolitis, pneumonia, asthma, or other pulmonary disease.

Intercostal Retractions

Alternate plural; see *Intercostal Retraction*.

Intercostal Space

The space between two neighboring ribs. It contains intercostal muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

Intercurrent Disease

An illness or complication that develops during the course of another disease or treatment and may affect its management or outcome.

Interdental Brush

A small brush designed to clean between teeth where a regular toothbrush cannot reach. It helps remove plaque and food and may reduce gum inflammation; brush sizes vary to fit different spaces.

Interdigital Neuroma

Alternate name; see *Morton's Neuroma*.

Interference

A factor that alters the accuracy or interpretation of a laboratory test, measurement, or drug effect.

Interferometry

A measurement method that uses interference between waves to determine distance, motion, thickness, optical properties, or other physical quantities.

Interferon

A major family of pleiotropic signaling glycoproteins and cytokines synthesized and secreted by host cells in response to viral pathogens, parasites, and neoplastic transformations. Classified into three distinct families: Type I interferons (primarily IFN-α, produced by plasmacytoid dendritic cells, and IFN-β, synthesized by fibroblasts), which bind the heterodimeric IFNAR1/IFNAR2 receptor complex to activate the JAK-STAT signaling pathway (JAK1/TYK2, STAT1/STAT2, IRF9 forming ISGF3), inducing hundreds of interferon-stimulated

genes (ISGs) including protein kinase R (PKR) and $2', 5'$-oligoadenylate synthetase (OAS) that arrest viral protein synthesis and degrade viral RNA; Type II interferon (IFN-γ), produced predominantly by CD4+ Th1 lymphocytes, CD8+ cytotoxic T cells, and natural killer (NK) cells, acting via IFNGR to activate macrophages, enhance MHC class I and II expression, and govern cell-mediated immunity; and Type III interferons (IFN-λ1–4), acting through IFNLR1/IL10R2 complexes primarily on mucosal epithelial barriers. Recombinant formulations are utilized clinically in chronic hepatitis B and C, relapsing-remitting multiple sclerosis (IFN-β), chronic granulomatous disease (IFN-γ), and specific malignancies (melanoma, Kaposi sarcoma, hairy cell leukemia).

Alternate Names:
IFN

Interferon-Alpha

A type I interferon cytokine with antiviral, antiproliferative, and immune-modulating effects; recombinant forms have been used for selected viral infections and cancers.

Interferon-Beta

A type I interferon cytokine used mainly as an immunomodulatory treatment for relapsing forms of multiple sclerosis.

Interferon Gamma Release Assay

A blood test that measures interferon-gamma released by sensitized T cells after exposure to antigens associated with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*. It detects tuberculosis infection, including latent infection, and is generally not affected by prior BCG vaccination. Commercial assays use different antigen preparations and methods; results do not distinguish latent infection from active disease by themselves.

Alternate Names:
IGRA

Interferon-Gamma Release Assay

Alternate spelling; see *Interferon Gamma Release Assay*.

Interferon Inducer

A substance that stimulates cells to produce interferons, proteins involved in antiviral and immune responses.

Interferonopathies

Rare inherited or acquired disorders in which interferon-driven immune activity remains abnormally high. They can cause ongoing inflammation, skin or lung disease, blood-vessel injury, or neurologic problems, often beginning in childhood.

Interferons

Plural form; see *Interferon*.

Interferon Signaling

The process by which interferons bind to cell receptors and activate genes that help defend against viruses, regulate immune cells, and sometimes slow cell growth. Different interferons act mainly on different tissues.

Interleukin

A diverse group of immunomodulatory cytokines synthesized primarily by CD4+ helper T lymphocytes, monocytes, macrophages, and endothelial cells that coordinate intercellular communication, leukocyte proliferation, maturation, migration, and systemic inflammatory cascades. Major subtypes include: IL-1 (IL-1α and IL-1β, potent pyrogens inducing fever via hypothalamic prostaglandin E2 synthesis, acute-phase reactants, and neutrophil mobilization); IL-2 (T-cell growth factor driving clonal expansion of effector and regulatory T cells); IL-4 and IL-13 (secreted by Th2 cells, inducing B-cell immunoglobulin class-switching to IgE and activating eosinophils in allergic inflammation); IL-6 (pleiotropic driver of hepatic CRP synthesis, thrombopoietin release, and plasma cell differentiation); IL-10 (potent anti-inflammatory cytokine inhibiting macrophage antigen presentation and pro-inflammatory cytokine secretion); IL-12 and IL-23 (promoting Th1 and Th17 differentiation, respectively); and IL-17 (recruiting neutrophils and driving autoimmune tissue destruction in psoriasis, ankylosing spondylitis, and inflammatory bowel

disease). Therapeutic monoclonal antibodies specifically target interleukin pathways (e.g., anakinra [anti-IL-1R], tocilizumab [anti-IL-6R], dupilumab [anti-IL-4Rα], ustekinumab [anti-IL-12/23p40], secukinumab [anti-IL-17A]).

Alternate Names:
IL; Interleukins

Interleukin 1

A group of proinflammatory cytokines, especially IL-1 alpha and IL-1 beta, that promote fever, leukocyte activation, and inflammatory responses.

Interleukin 13

A cytokine produced by type 2 helper T cells and other immune cells that contributes to allergic inflammation, mucus production, and tissue fibrosis.

Interleukin 2

Interleukin-2 is a T-cell growth factor that promotes proliferation and survival of activated T cells and natural-killer cells; high-dose therapy can cause capillary-leak syndrome and systemic toxicity.

Interleukin-6

A cytokine involved in immune regulation and inflammation that stimulates production of acute-phase proteins by the liver.

Interleukin 7

A cytokine important for development, survival, and homeostasis of T lymphocytes and some B-cell precursors.

Interleukins

Plural form; see *Interleukin*.

Alternate Names:
ILs

INTERMACS Profile

A seven-level system for describing how sick a person is with advanced heart failure. Profile 1 means critical shock with very poor blood flow; profiles 2 and 3 describe worsening or dependence on medicines that strengthen the heart. Profiles 4 through 7 describe repeated hospital stays or increasing limits on activity. The profile helps doctors judge urgency and timing for a heart pump or transplant.

Alternate Names:
INTERMACS Staging; INTERMACS Scale

Intermediate

Intermediate means between two stages, positions, or levels, such as an intermediate metabolite, cell, or developmental phase.

Intermediate Cuneiform

The smallest of three cuneiform bones in the middle of the foot. It lies between the other cuneiform bones and joins the navicular bone and second metatarsal, helping support the foot's arch.

Intermediate-Density Lipoprotein

A temporary particle formed when the body removes some fat from very-low-density lipoprotein. It can be changed into LDL, the type of cholesterol particle that can contribute to fatty buildup in artery walls.

Alternate Names:
IDL

Intermediate Filament

An intermediate filament is a strong cytoskeletal fiber that supports cell shape, mechanical stability, and tissue integrity.

Intermediate Uveitis

Inflammation mainly affecting the gel inside the eye and nearby tissues at the edge of the retina. It may cause blurred vision, floaters, or little pain and can be linked to autoimmune disease, infection, or no identified cause. Eye examination and imaging guide treatment and monitoring for complications.

Intermittent Auscultation

Checking a baby's heart rate at regular intervals during labor with a handheld Doppler or fetoscope rather than recording it continuously. The timing depends on the stage of labor, pregnancy risks, symptoms, and local clinical practice.

Intermittent Claudication

Cramping, aching, or weakness in a leg muscle that reliably starts with walking or exercise and improves with rest. It usually results from narrowed leg arteries and may indicate peripheral artery disease.

Intermittent Explosive Disorder

A mental-health disorder causing repeated, sudden outbursts of verbal or physical aggression that are far greater than the situation warrants. The outbursts are impulsive, not planned, and cause distress or problems in daily life; diagnosis is made from the pattern and history.

Intermittent Fasting

An eating pattern that alternates planned periods of eating with periods of little or no food. Common schedules limit daily eating hours or use selected fasting days. It may help some adults lose weight, but it is not suitable for everyone, especially during pregnancy or with some medical conditions or eating disorders.

Intermittent Fever

A fever that rises and falls with periods when temperature returns to normal or near normal.

Intermittent Mandatory Ventilation

A mechanical ventilation mode in which preset mechanical volume- or pressure-cycled mandatory breaths are delivered at fixed periodic intervals, while permitting spontaneous unassisted or pressure-supported breaths between mandatory cycles.

Alternate Names:
IMV

Intermenstrual Bleeding

Uterine or vaginal bleeding that occurs between normal menstrual periods; see *Metrorrhagia*.

Intern

A physician in the early stage of postgraduate medical training, traditionally the first year after medical school; the exact training structure varies by country.

Internal

Internal means located within the body, an organ, a structure, or a system rather than on its outer surface.

Internal Bleeding

Internal bleeding is blood loss into a body cavity, tissue, or organ rather than through an obvious external wound. Trauma, ulcers, aneurysm, pregnancy complications, medicines, and tumors can cause it; faintness, shock, abdominal swelling, black stool, or vomiting blood may occur.

Internal Capsule

A compact bundle of nerve fibers deep inside the brain that carries movement and sensation signals between the brain's outer layer and lower brain and spinal centers. Damage can cause weakness, numbness, or other neurologic deficits.

Internal Capsule Stroke

A stroke affecting the internal capsule, a compact pathway carrying motor and sensory fibers between the brain and body. A small infarct may cause contralateral weakness, sensory loss, or combined sensorimotor symptoms; the pattern depends on the location and extent of injury. Nearby lesions can produce similar findings, so symptoms alone do not establish the precise site.

Internal Carotid Artery

A branch of the common carotid artery that enters the skull and supplies the brain, eyes, and related structures. It contributes to the cerebral arterial circulation.

Internal Carotid Artery Dissection

A tear in the tunica intima of the extracranial internal carotid artery leading to intramural hematoma formation within the arterial wall, manifesting classically with ipsilateral frontotemporal or retro-orbital headache, neck pain, partial Horner syndrome (ptosis and miosis without anhidrosis), and ischemic stroke in young adults.

Alternate Names:
ICAD

Internal Condom

A thin pouch inserted into the vagina or anus during sex to reduce the chance of pregnancy and transmission of some sexually transmitted infections.

Alternate Names:
Female Condom; Female Condoms

Internal Environment

The fluid and physiologic conditions inside the body that cells require, including temperature, pH, oxygen, electrolytes, and nutrients.

Internal Fixation

Surgical stabilization of a fracture or unstable bone using implanted hardware such as plates, screws, rods, wires, or pins.

Internal Fixator

An internal fixator is a surgically implanted plate, screw, rod, nail, or frame used to stabilize a fracture or correct skeletal alignment.

Internal Hernia

A loop of intestine slips through an opening inside the abdominal cavity, often after abdominal surgery. It can cause intermittent or sudden bowel obstruction with abdominal pain, vomiting, and bloating.

Internal Iliac Artery

A major artery branching from the pelvic arteries. It supplies blood to the pelvic organs, buttocks, pelvic muscles, reproductive organs, bladder, and parts of the rectum.

Internal Iliac Vein

A vein draining the pelvic organs, pelvic wall, and gluteal region that joins the external iliac vein to form the common iliac vein.

Internal Jugular Vein

A large vein in the neck that drains blood from the brain, face, and neck back to the heart. It joins another major vein behind the collarbone and is sometimes used for central intravenous access.

Internal Jugular Vein Cannulation

The percutaneous placement of an indwelling central venous catheter into the internal jugular vein, conventionally performed under real-time ultrasound guidance between the sternal and clavicular heads of the sternocleidomastoid muscle for central venous pressure monitoring, inotropic drug administration, or hemodialysis access.

Alternate Names:
IJ Line Placement

Internal Jugular Vein Thrombosis

A blood clot in the large vein that carries blood from the head and neck toward the heart. It may cause neck pain or swelling and can be linked to infection, a vein catheter, cancer, or a condition that makes blood clot easily.

Jugular Vein Thrombosis

Alternate name; see *Internal Jugular Vein Thrombosis*.

Alternate Names:
IJV Thrombosis; Jugular Vein Phlebothrombosis

Internal Medicine

The medical specialty focused on prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of illness in adults. Internists provide comprehensive care across organ systems, including complex or multiple conditions, in outpatient and hospital settings; some pursue subspecialty training in areas such as cardiology, nephrology, or oncology.

Internal Oblique Muscle

A broad muscle layer in the side of the abdominal wall. It helps compress the abdomen, bend and rotate the trunk, support the spine, and strengthen the groin and abdominal wall.

Internal Podalic Version

A rare obstetric procedure in which a clinician turns a baby inside the uterus by bringing the feet downward, usually to deliver a second twin in an unusual position. It carries serious risks and is performed only in selected emergencies by an experienced specialist.

Internal Resorption

Destruction of tooth tissue from the inside of the tooth outward, caused by activity of specialized cells. It may produce a pink area or no symptoms and can weaken the tooth; dental imaging determines whether root-canal treatment can save it.

International Classification of Diseases

A World Health Organization system for coding diseases, injuries, and other health conditions. Versions such as ICD-10 and ICD-11 support clinical records, statistics, and billing; a code does not replace a clinical diagnosis.

International Normalized Ratio

The INR, a standardized calculation from the prothrombin time used to assess blood clotting and guide treatment with vitamin K antagonists such as warfarin.

International Unit

A unit that measures the biological effect of a substance, such as insulin, a vitamin, or a vaccine. The amount represented by one unit differs between substances, so international units cannot be directly converted to milligrams without knowing the substance.

Interneuron

An interneuron connects neurons within the central nervous system and helps integrate, inhibit, or coordinate neural signals.

Interneurons

Alternate plural; see *Interneuron*.

Internist

A physician specializing in internal medicine who provides comprehensive care for adults. Internists diagnose and manage acute and chronic illnesses affecting any organ system, including complex or multiple conditions. They may practice general primary care or hospital medicine, or complete further training in an internal-medicine subspecialty.

Alternate Names: Internal Medicine Physician; Doctor of Internal Medicine

Internuclear Ophthalmoplegia

A disorder of coordinated side-to-side eye movement caused by damage to a nerve pathway in the brainstem. One eye may not move inward properly, causing double vision or jerky eye movements; stroke and multiple sclerosis are common causes.

Interosseous

Interosseous means located between bones, such as the membrane or muscles between the forearm or lower-leg bones.

Interosseous Nerve Syndrome

Neuropathy affecting an interosseous nerve in the forearm. Anterior interosseous nerve palsy weakens flexion of the thumb interphalangeal joint and index-finger distal interphalangeal joint, impairing tip-to-tip pinch; posterior interosseous nerve palsy weakens finger and thumb extension while usually sparing cutaneous sensation. These are distinct syndromes with different nerve functions.

Interpersonal Psychotherapy

A time-limited talking therapy, used especially for depression, that links mood symptoms with relationships and life changes. It helps address grief, conflict, role changes, loneliness, communication, and social support.

Interphalangeal Dislocation

Displacement of a finger or toe joint between phalanges, usually after hyperextension, twisting, or direct impact. Pain, deformity, swelling, and restricted motion occur; fractures, tendon injury, and neurovascular compromise may accompany it.

Interphalangeal Joint

A joint between the bones of a finger or toe. These joints mainly allow the digit to bend and straighten.

Interphase

Interphase is the portion of the cell cycle between

divisions, including growth, DNA replication, and preparation for mitosis or meiosis.

Interphase Cell

A cell between divisions that grows, performs normal functions, and copies its DNA before possible division.

Interproximal Caries

Dental caries occurring on the contact surfaces between adjacent teeth. It may be difficult to detect clinically and is commonly assessed with bitewing radiographs when imaging is indicated.

Interrupted Aortic Arch

A rare congenital heart defect in which the aorta has a complete gap between its ascending and descending parts. Newborns can rapidly develop poor circulation and heart failure.

Intersexual

Older term; see *Differences Of Sex Development*.

Interstitial

Relating to the spaces between cells or tissues, such as interstitial fluid or interstitial lung disease.

Interstitial Cystitis

A long-lasting condition, also called bladder pain syndrome, that causes pain, pressure, or tenderness felt in the bladder or pelvis together with urinary symptoms. Pain often worsens as the bladder fills and improves after urination; frequent urination and a sudden urge to urinate are common, and sex may be painful. Symptoms may flare and then improve. There is no single known cause. The diagnosis is based on the symptoms and examination while other conditions with similar symptoms, such as a urinary infection, are considered or ruled out.

Alternate Names:
IC; Bladder Pain Syndrome; Painful Bladder Syndrome

Interstitial Fluid

Interstitial fluid is the fluid surrounding tissue cells, formed from blood plasma and returned to circulation through lymphatic vessels.

Interstitial Granulomatous Dermatitis

A rare inflammatory skin disorder that causes red, purple, or brown patches or raised areas, often on both sides of the body. It may be linked to autoimmune disease, medicines, or another illness.

Interstitial Keratitis

Inflammation of the corneal stroma without primary involvement of the corneal surface. It may follow infection, autoimmune disease, or trauma and can cause pain, photophobia, redness, and reduced vision.

Interstitial Lung Disease

A large, diverse group of lung conditions that cause progressive inflammation and scarring of the interstitium—the delicate lace-like tissue surrounding the microscopic air sacs (alveoli) of the lungs. The scarring makes the lungs stiff and hampers the passage of oxygen into the blood. Causes include autoimmune diseases (such as rheumatoid arthritis or scleroderma), long-term exposure to hazardous dusts or molds, certain medications, or unknown factors.

Alternate Names:
ILD; Diffuse Parenchymal Lung Disease (DPLD)

Interstitial Nephritis

Inflammation of the renal interstitium and tubules, which can be acute or chronic. Acute interstitial nephritis is most commonly caused by medications, particularly NSAIDs, antibiotics including penicillins and cephalosporins, and proton pump inhibitors.

Interstitial (Nonidiopathic) Pulmonary Fibrosis

Fibrotic interstitial lung disease with an identifiable or suspected cause, such as connective-tissue disease, occupational exposure, medicines, radiation, or chronic hypersensitivity pneumonitis. Management combines exposure control, treatment of the cause, monitoring, and selected anti-inflammatory

or antifibrotic therapy.

Interstitial Pneumonia

Inflammation affecting the supporting tissue around the lung air sacs. It may be caused by infection, autoimmune disease, medicines, or other lung disorders and can cause dry cough, fever, breathlessness, and low oxygen. Examination and imaging help determine the cause and treatment.

Interstitial Pulmonary Fibrosis

Scarring in the supporting tissue between the lung air sacs, which can reduce oxygen transfer. It may cause progressive breathlessness and dry cough; causes include autoimmune disease, medicines, radiation, or no identified cause.

Interstitium

The supporting tissue between and around the lung air sacs, capillaries, and small airways; inflammation or fibrosis of this tissue can impair lung expansion and gas exchange.

Intertrigo

Intertrigo is inflammation in opposing skin folds caused by moisture, heat, friction, and maceration; Candida or bacterial infection may complicate the tender erythematous rash.

Alternate Names:
Intertriginous Dermatitis

Intertrochanteric Fracture

An extracapsular fracture of the proximal femur occurring along the dense trabecular line extending between the greater and lesser trochanters, carrying a low risk of avascular femoral head necrosis compared to femoral neck fractures, commonly treated with a cephalomedullary nail or sliding hip screw.

Ischiofemoral Impingement

Pinching of soft tissue between the sitting bone of the pelvis and the thighbone. It may irritate a nearby muscle and cause deep buttock or groin pain, often worse when the leg moves backward or turns inward.

Interval

An interval is the time, distance, or range between two points or events, such as a dosing or follow-up interval.

Intervening Sequence

A nucleotide sequence within a gene transcript that lies between coding sequences; in many genes it is an intron removed during RNA processing.

Intervention

An action intended to prevent, diagnose, treat, or change a health condition or outcome, such as a medicine, procedure, counseling, or public-health measure.

Alternate Names:
Medical Intervention; Clinical Intervention

Interventional

Relating to a procedure or active treatment used to diagnose or manage disease, often through minimally invasive access rather than open surgery.

Interventional Cardiology

A subspecialty using catheter-based procedures to diagnose and treat coronary, structural, and selected vascular heart conditions, including angioplasty, stenting, and transcatheter valve procedures.

Interventional Procedure

A targeted procedure used to diagnose or treat disease, often through a needle, tube, or small incision and guided by imaging. Examples include biopsy, drainage, vessel treatment, and tumor ablation; risks depend on the body area and technique.

Interventional Procedures

Alternate plural; see *Interventional Procedure*.

Interventional Radiologist

A physician trained to perform minimally invasive diagnostic and therapeutic procedures using medical imaging for guidance.

Interventional Radiology

A specialty using imaging guidance to perform minimally invasive diagnostic and therapeutic procedures, such as biopsies, drainages, embolization, and vascular treatments.

Interventricular Septum

The wall between the heart's two lower chambers. It is mostly muscle and helps the heart pump effectively; it also contains part of the electrical system that coordinates the heartbeat.

Intervertebral Disc

A strong, flexible cushion between neighboring spinal bones. It absorbs shock and allows limited movement; a bulging or damaged disc can irritate nearby nerves and cause back or neck pain, numbness, or weakness.

Intervertebral Disk

Alternate spelling; see *Intervertebral Disc*.

Intervertebral Foramen

An opening between two neighboring bones of the spine through which a spinal nerve leaves the spinal canal. Narrowing of this opening can press on the nerve and cause pain, numbness, tingling, or weakness in its area of the body.

Alternate Names:
Neural foramen

Intestinal Absorption

Movement of digested nutrients, water, vitamins, and salts through the intestinal lining into the blood or lymph. Damage to the intestine, pancreas, liver, or bile flow can reduce absorption and cause deficiency.

Intestinal Amebiasis

Alternate name; see *Amebiasis*.

Intestinal Angina

A clinical manifestation of chronic mesenteric ischemia characterized by severe, cramping, periumbilical or epigastric abdominal pain developing 30 to 60 minutes after eating ('food fear'), leading to progressive weight loss, caused by severe atherosclerotic stenosis of two or more mesenteric arteries.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Mesenteric Ischemia; Postprandial Abdominal Angina

Intestinal Atresia

A birth defect in which part of the intestine is closed or missing, blocking passage of milk and digestive contents. Newborns may develop swollen abdomen, vomiting, and failure to feed and usually need surgery.

Intestinal Cancer

A cancer that begins in the small or large intestine. It may cause pain, bleeding, anemia, altered bowel habits, blockage, or weight loss, but early disease may cause no symptoms; diagnosis and treatment depend on its site and stage.

Intestinal Carcinoid Tumor

A neuroendocrine tumor arising in the intestine, especially the ileum or jejunum. It may be incidental or cause pain, obstruction, bleeding, or hormone-related carcinoid syndrome after liver or other metastases develop.

Intestinal Crypts

Small glands in the intestinal lining that make mucus and help replace worn-out lining cells.

Intestinal Diseases

Diseases of the small or large intestine include infection, inflammation, poor absorption, blockage, polyps, and cancer. Symptoms may include pain, diarrhea, constipation, bleeding, vomiting, weight loss, or nutritional deficiency.

Intestinal Duplication

A birth difference in which an extra segment or cyst develops beside or within the intestine. It may cause no symptoms or lead to pain, bleeding, infection, blockage, or twisting of the bowel.

Intestinal Failure

Gut function reduced below the level needed to absorb enough nutrients, water, or electrolytes to maintain health or growth, requiring intravenous supplementation. Causes include short bowel, extensive disease of the intestinal lining, intestinal fistula, impaired intestinal movement, and mechanical blockage. The term applies when these problems require intravenous nutrition or fluids, not to malabsorption alone.

Intestinal Fistula

An abnormal passage connecting the intestine with another organ, another bowel segment, or the skin. It may develop after inflammation, infection, surgery, or injury and can cause leakage, infection, dehydration, or poor nutrition.

Intestinal Flukes

Parasitic flatworms that infect the intestine after contaminated food or water is consumed. Infection may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, malabsorption, or nutritional problems, and diagnosis depends on exposure history and stool or other testing.

Intestinal Ganglioneuromatosis

A rare, usually noncancerous overgrowth of nerve cells and supporting fibers in the intestinal wall. It may cause pain, diarrhea, constipation, or blockage and can occur with certain inherited tumor syndromes.

Intestinal Gas

Gas within the digestive tract that may cause belching, bloating, abdominal discomfort, passing wind, or symptoms from an underlying digestive disorder.

Intestinal Ischemia

Too little blood flow reaching the intestines. It may develop suddenly from a clot or blockage, or gradually from narrowed arteries, and can cause severe pain, bloody stools, or bowel damage.

Alternate Names:
Mesenteric Ischemia; Bowel Ischemia

Intestinal Leiomyoma

A usually benign smooth-muscle tumor arising in the wall of the intestine; symptoms depend on size and location and may include bleeding, obstruction, or abdominal pain.

Intestinal Lipodystrophy

Alternate name; see *Whipple's Disease*.

Intestinal Lipomatosis

A usually noncancerous overgrowth of fatty tissue in the intestinal wall. It often causes no symptoms, but larger areas can lead to bleeding, bowel blockage, or telescoping of one bowel segment into another.

Intestinal Lymphangiectasia

Dilation or obstruction of intestinal lymphatic vessels, causing leakage of lymph into the bowel and loss of protein, lymphocytes, and fat-soluble vitamins. It may produce edema, diarrhea, abdominal symptoms, or poor growth.

Intestinal Lymphoma

A cancer of immune-system cells that begins in the small or large intestine. It may cause abdominal pain, weight loss, diarrhea, bleeding, or blockage; diagnosis requires tissue sampling and specialist evaluation.

Intestinal Malrotation

A birth defect in which the intestines do not move into their usual position before birth. It can allow the bowel to twist and lose its blood supply, causing green vomiting, pain, swelling, or sudden illness in an infant.

Intestinal Malabsorption

Alternate name; see *Malabsorption*.

Intestinal Metaplasia

A change in which the normal lining of the stomach or another area becomes more like the lining of the intestine, usually after long-term irritation or inflammation. Some forms increase the future risk of stomach cancer.

Intestinal Microbiome

The community of microorganisms living in the intestines. These organisms can affect digestion, vitamin production, immune activity, and protection from harmful germs.

Intestinal Motility

The muscle movements that mix and push food, fluid, and stool through the intestines.

Intestinal Motility Disorders

Alternate name; see *Gastrointestinal Motility Disorder*.

Intestinal Mucosa

The inner lining of the intestine, where digestion and nutrient absorption occur. It produces mucus and contains immune defenses that help protect the body from germs and harmful substances in food.

Intestinal Obstruction

A partial or complete blockage that prevents food, fluid, and gas from moving normally through the intestine. Adhesions, hernias, tumors, inflammation, twisting, or poor bowel movement can cause pain, swelling, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Intestinal Obstruction And Ileus

Impaired passage of intestinal contents caused by a mechanical blockage or by reduced bowel motility without a physical blockage; symptoms commonly include abdominal pain, distension, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Intestinal Obstruction Repair

Surgery or another intervention to relieve an intestinal blockage, remove a diseased segment when necessary, and restore bowel continuity or create a stoma when required.

Intestinal Parasite

A protozoan or worm that lives in the gastrointestinal tract and may cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, anemia, malnutrition, or no symptoms.

Intestinal Perforation

A hole through the bowel wall that allows digestive contents and bacteria into the abdomen. It may result from inflammation, infection, blockage, injury, or surgery and can cause severe pain, abdominal rigidity, infection, and shock.

Intestinal Polyp

A growth that projects from the inner lining of the small or large intestine. Many are harmless, but some can slowly become cancer, so their size, number, type, and location guide follow-up or removal.

Intestinal Polyps

Alternate plural name; see *Intestinal Polyp*.

Intestinal Polyposis

The presence of many polyps in the intestine. It may be inherited or acquired and can cause bleeding, anemia, blockage, or increased cancer risk; evaluation often includes colonoscopy and family-history assessment.

Intestinal Pseudo-Obstruction

Bowel swelling and symptoms of blockage caused by poor intestinal movement despite no physical obstruction. It may be temporary after illness or surgery or result from a long-term nerve or muscle disorder.

Intestinal Resection

Surgery to remove part of the small or large intestine because of disease or injury. The remaining ends may be rejoined, or an opening may be made through the abdominal wall for stool to pass.

Intestinal Transplant

Transplantation of a donor small intestine to treat irreversible intestinal failure when adequate nutrition and fluid balance cannot be maintained by other means. It may be performed alone or with a liver and other abdominal organs and requires lifelong immunosuppression and monitoring for rejection, infection, and graft complications.

Intestinal Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis infection affecting the intestine, most often the area where the small and large intestines meet. It may cause abdominal pain, fever, weight loss, or changes in bowel habits and can resemble Crohn disease. It can also lead to narrowing or blockage of the bowel.

Intestinal Volvulus

Alternate name; see *Volvulus*.

Intestinal Villi

Tiny finger-like projections lining the small intestine that greatly increase its surface area. Their blood and lymph vessels absorb digested nutrients; damage to them can cause diarrhea, weight loss, and nutritional deficiencies.

Intestinal Wall

The layers of tissue that surround the intestinal passage. They move intestinal contents, absorb nutrients and water, and help protect against harmful substances.

Intestine

The part of the digestive tract extending from the stomach to the anus, consisting of the small intestine and large intestine.

Intestine Disorder

Alternate name; see *Intestinal Diseases*.

Intestine Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the small or large intestine. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause bleeding, anemia, pain, altered bowel movements, blockage, or no symptoms.

Intestine Obstruction

Alternate name; see *Intestinal Obstruction*.

Intimal Dissection

A tear in the inner lining of an artery that allows blood to enter and split the vessel wall, creating a false lumen. Aortic or other arterial dissection can compromise blood flow and is a medical emergency.

Intimal Hyperplasia

Thickening of the inner lining of an artery after injury, surgery, a stent, or a vascular graft. The narrowing can reduce blood flow and cause a treated artery or dialysis access to become blocked again.

Intimate Partner Violence In Pregnancy

Physical, sexual, or psychological abuse by a current or former partner during pregnancy. It can harm the pregnant person and fetus and is associated with complications such as injury, preterm birth, and placental abruption.

Intolerance

An adverse response to a substance that does not involve the immune mechanism of an allergy.

Alternate Names:
Nonallergic Sensitivity; Food Intolerance

Intoxication

A state of physical or mental impairment caused by recent exposure to a substance, such as alcohol, a medicine, or another drug.

Intra-Abdominal Abscess

A pocket of pus inside the abdomen, often near the bowel, pelvis, or diaphragm. It may cause fever, abdominal pain, vomiting, or general illness and can develop after infection, inflammation, injury, or surgery.

Intraabdominal Cancer

Cancer arising in an organ or tissue within the abdomen, such as the bowel, stomach, liver, pancreas, ovaries, or abdominal lining. Symptoms and treatment depend on the organ, cancer type, extent, and overall health.

Intraabdominal Hemorrhage

Bleeding inside the abdominal cavity, often after trauma, surgery, rupture of an organ or blood vessel, pregnancy complications, or internal disease. It may cause pain, swelling, dizziness, or shock.

Intraabdominal Hernia

A loop of intestine or other abdominal tissue slips through an abnormal opening inside the abdominal cavity rather than through the abdominal wall. It can cause pain, vomiting, and bowel obstruction.

Intra-Abdominal Hypertension

A sustained or repeated pathological elevation of intra-abdominal pressure equal to or exceeding 12 mmHg (measured via transvesical bladder pressure catheterization), which when exceeding 20 mmHg with new organ failure defines abdominal compartment syndrome.

Alternate Names:
IAH

Intraabdominal Infection

An infection within the abdominal cavity, such as peritonitis or an abscess, often requiring antibiotics and sometimes drainage or surgery.

Intra-Abdominal Sepsis

Sepsis arising from an infection within the abdominal cavity, commonly due to bowel perforation, peritonitis, an abscess, ischemic bowel, or a leak after surgery. It may cause abdominal pain, fever, ileus, organ dysfunction, shock, or failure of multiple organs.

Intra-Aortic Balloon Pump

A temporary heart-support device with a balloon inside the body's main artery. It inflates and deflates with each heartbeat to improve blood flow and reduce the heart's workload; bleeding, infection, and reduced limb blood flow can occur.

Intra-Arterial

Intra-arterial means within an artery, including a catheter, injection, infusion, or measurement performed directly in an arterial vessel.

Intraarticular

Intraarticular means within a joint, such as an injection, fracture, loose body, or inflammatory process inside the joint space.

Intra-Articular Injection

An injection into a joint space, such as the knee, shoulder, hip, or ankle. It may deliver medicine or remove joint fluid; corticosteroids, local anesthetics, and other substances may be used for selected joint problems.

Alternate Names:
Joint Injection; Intraarticular Injection

Intrabronchial

Intrabronchial means within a bronchus, one of the air passages branching from the trachea into the lungs.

Intracardiac Echocardiography

An invasive imaging modality in which a steerable catheter-tipped ultrasound probe is introduced via the femoral vein into the cardiac chambers (usually the right atrium) to provide real-time, high-resolution visualization of endocardial structures and guide structural heart and electrophysiology interventions.

Alternate Names:
ICE

Intracardiac Electrophysiology Study

An invasive test using electrode catheters inside the heart to record electrical activity and provoke or map arrhythmias, helping guide diagnosis and treatment.

Intracartilaginous

Located within cartilage, such as a lesion, injection, or developing structure. The term identifies position and does not by itself indicate whether the finding is normal, injured, inflamed, or cancerous.

Intracavernosal Injection

An injection of a prescription medicine into the erectile tissue of the penis to treat erectile dysfunction. The medicine relaxes muscle and widens blood vessels, producing an erection that does not require sexual stimulation. Pain, bruising, scar tissue, or a prolonged painful erection can occur.

Alternate Names:

ICI; Penile Injection Therapy; Intracavernous Injection

Intracavitary

Intracavitary means within a body cavity, such as a treatment, device, fluid, or lesion located in the thorax, abdomen, uterus, or another cavity.

Intracavity Radiotherapy

Intracavity radiotherapy places a radiation source inside a body cavity near a tumor, commonly to treat selected cancers of the cervix, uterus, or vagina.

Intracellular

Inside a cell or occurring within a cell. Intracellular fluid contains most of the body's potassium and magnesium, whereas sodium is found mainly outside cells. The cell membrane controls movement of water and dissolved substances between the cell and its surroundings.

Intracellular Fluid

The fluid contained within cells, comprising approximately two thirds of total body water in a typical adult. Its major solutes include potassium, magnesium, phosphate, and intracellular proteins, and its composition is maintained by selective membrane transport.

Intracellular Membrane

A membrane inside a cell that separates compartments and controls movement of substances between them.

Intracellular Pathogens

Germs that live and multiply inside the body's cells. Viruses always do this, and some bacteria do as well; living inside cells can make them harder for immune defenses and some medicines to eliminate.

Intracellular Transport

Movement of proteins and other materials within a cell, often in membrane-bound sacs along the cell's internal framework.

Intracerebral

Intracerebral means within the brain tissue, as in an intracerebral hemorrhage, injection, electrode, or lesion.

Intracerebral Hemorrhage

Bleeding directly into brain tissue, usually from a small ruptured artery. It can cause sudden headache, weakness, vomiting, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Intracisternal

Intracisternal means within a cistern, especially a cerebrospinal-fluid space at the base of the brain.

Intracoronal

Located within the crown of a tooth. In cardiology, the related term *intracoronary* means within a coronary artery.

Intracoronary

Intracoronary means within a coronary artery or the coronary circulation, such as a catheter, stent, imaging study, or medicine delivery.

Intracranial

Inside the skull. The term may describe the brain, blood vessels, fluid, bleeding, pressure, infection, or a growth within the skull. Extra fluid, blood, or tissue can raise pressure and damage the brain, causing headache, vomiting, confusion, weakness, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Intracranial Aneurysm

A weakened, bulging area in a blood vessel inside the skull, usually in an artery supplying the brain. Many cause no symptoms, but a leak or rupture can cause bleeding around the brain and a sudden, severe headache.

Intracranial Hemorrhage

Bleeding inside the skull, either within the brain or around it. It may follow injury, high blood pressure, a ruptured aneurysm, or medicines that prevent clotting and can rapidly cause brain pressure, disability,

or death.

Intracranial Hypertension

Higher than normal pressure inside the skull. Causes include brain swelling, bleeding, a tumor or other growth, or too much fluid around the brain. It can cause headache, vomiting, vision problems, sleepiness, or serious brain injury.

Alternate Names:
Raised Intracranial Pressure; Increased Intracranial Pressure

Intracranial Pressure

The pressure inside the skull produced by the brain, blood, and surrounding fluid. Too much pressure can reduce blood flow to the brain and cause headache, vomiting, confusion, unequal pupils, seizures, unconsciousness, or life-threatening brain injury.

Intracranial Pressure Monitoring

Continuous or intermittent measurement of pressure inside the skull, usually in critically ill patients with severe brain injury, hemorrhage, hydrocephalus, or other risk of intracranial hypertension.

Intracranial Venous Malformations

Abnormal collections or connections of veins within the skull that may bleed or affect nearby brain tissue.

Intractable

Difficult to control, relieve, or cure despite appropriate treatment, as in intractable pain or seizures.

Intracytoplasmic Sperm Injection

A fertility treatment in which a single sperm is injected directly into an egg in a laboratory to help achieve fertilisation.

Alternate Names:
ICSI

Intradermal

Located within the dermis, the layer of skin beneath the epidermis; an intradermal injection places medication or test material into that layer.

Intradermal Nevus

A common, benign melanocytic skin nevus characterized by nests of mature melanocytes located entirely within the dermis without junctional melanocytic proliferation, appearing as a soft, dome-shaped, skin-colored, pedunculated or light brown papule.

Alternate Names:
Intradermal Melanocytic Nevus; Dermal Mole

Intradermal Skin Test

A small amount of a test substance is injected into the top layer of the skin. The area is then checked for a reaction. This method is used for tests such as tuberculin testing and some allergy tests.

Intraductal Carcinoma

A carcinoma involving ductal spaces; the term's meaning depends on the organ and does not always mean the cancer is confined in situ. In the breast, it commonly refers to ductal carcinoma in situ, which has not invaded surrounding tissue. Intraductal carcinoma of the prostate is a distinct, usually aggressive form of prostate cancer that spreads within ducts and glands.

Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm

A cyst-forming growth in a pancreatic duct that produces mucus. Some types can progress to pancreatic cancer; evaluation and follow-up depend on imaging features and other risk factors.

Alternate Names:
IPMN; Pancreatic IPMN

Intraductal Papilloma

A benign growth of cells within a breast milk duct. A solitary papilloma near the nipple may cause spontaneous clear or bloody discharge; multiple papillomas or papillomas with atypical cells have different associations with breast cancer risk.

Alternate Names:
Ductal Papilloma; Solitary Intraductal Papilloma; Breast Papilloma

Intraduodenal

Intraduodenal means within the duodenum, the first part of the small intestine beyond the stomach.

Intraepidermal

Intraepidermal means within the epidermis, the outermost layer of skin.

Intraepithelial

Located within the layer of cells that covers a body surface or lines an organ. The word may describe infection, inflammation, or abnormal cell changes that have not yet grown through the supporting layer beneath them.

Intraesophageal

Intraesophageal means within the esophagus, such as a probe, pressure sensor, lesion, or medication delivery.

Intrahepatic

Within the liver. For example, intrahepatic bile-duct blockage or inflammation can cause jaundice and abnormal liver tests, while a tumor may begin in liver cells or in bile ducts inside the liver. The exact meaning depends on the condition being described.

Intrahepatic Cholangiocarcinoma

Cancer arising in bile ducts within the liver, also called intrahepatic bile-duct cancer. It is distinct from perihilar and distal cholangiocarcinoma and from hepatocellular carcinoma, which arises from liver cells.

Alternate Names:
Intrahepatic Bile Duct Cancer; iCCA

Intrahepatic Cholestasis

Reduced bile flow within the liver causing bile substances to build up in blood, often producing itching, jaundice, dark urine, or pale stools.

Intrahepatic Cholestasis Of Pregnancy

A pregnancy-related liver disorder causing intense itching, often on the palms and soles, without a primary rash. Bile acids rise in the blood and can increase fetal risk, so testing and obstetric monitoring are needed.

Intralesional

Delivered directly into a lesion, such as an injection of corticosteroid into a keloid or a medicine into a skin, joint, or tumor lesion. The drug, dose, sterility, and lesion type determine safety.

Intralymphatic

Intralymphatic means within a lymphatic vessel or channel, such as a medicine, tumor spread, infection, or imaging contrast.

Intramedullary

Intramedullary means within the medulla of an organ or the central canal of a bone, especially an implant placed inside a long bone.

Intramedullary Nail

A metal implant inserted into the medullary canal of a long bone to align and stabilize a fracture. It shares load along the bone axis and is commonly used for femoral and tibial shaft fractures.

Intramedullary Spinal Cord Abscesses

Localized collections of pus within the spinal cord, usually caused by infection and associated with severe neurologic deficits, fever, or spinal pain. MRI and urgent antimicrobial and surgical evaluation are typically required.

Intramural Hematoma

Bleeding into the wall of the digestive tract, often in the small intestine. It can follow injury or blood-thinning treatment and may cause abdominal pain, vomiting, or blockage.

Intramural Plaque

An intramural plaque is an atherosclerotic deposit within an artery wall that can narrow the lumen or destabilize and cause thrombosis.

Intramuscular

Within a muscle. An intramuscular injection deliv-

ers a medicine into muscle tissue, commonly in the upper arm, thigh, or hip, where it is absorbed into the bloodstream.

Intramuscular Injection

Delivery of a medicine into a muscle with a needle. The injection site and needle size depend on the medicine and the person's age and body size; pain, bleeding, infection, or nerve injury are possible.

Intramuscular Injection Technique

The method used to place medicine into muscle tissue with a needle and syringe. The site, needle, and injection method vary with the medicine and the person.

Intramuscular Myxoma

A rare, usually noncancerous tumor made of jelly-like tissue within a skeletal muscle. It often appears as a slow-growing painless lump, but imaging or biopsy may be needed to distinguish it from other masses.

Intraocular

Within the eyeball. The term may describe a medicine injection, lens, infection, bleeding, foreign body, pressure, or other finding inside the eye. Increased pressure inside the eye can damage the optic nerve and cause permanent loss of vision.

Intraocular Infection

An infection inside the eye, such as endophthalmitis, that can rapidly threaten vision.

Intraocular Lens

An artificial lens placed inside the eye, usually during cataract surgery, to focus light after the cloudy natural lens is removed. Lens choices can emphasize distance, near vision, or astigmatism correction. Possible complications include glare, clouding behind the lens, infection, or retinal problems.

Intraocular Lens Dislocation

Movement of an artificial lens away from its intended position after eye surgery. It may cause blurred or double vision, glare, or pain and can require repositioning or replacement by an eye specialist.

Intraocular Lens Implant

An artificial lens implanted inside the eye, usually during cataract surgery; see *Intraocular Lens*.

Intraocular Lens Implantation

The surgical insertion of an artificial synthetic lens inside the eye, typically following removal of a cloudy cataractous natural lens; see *Intraocular Lens Implant* and *Cataract Surgery*.

Intraocular Lymphoma

A lymphoma involving the eye, often the jelly-like vitreous or the retina. It may cause blurred vision, floaters, or inflammation and can occur with lymphoma in the brain or other parts of the body.

Intraocular Pressure

The pressure of fluid inside the eye. If it stays too high, it can damage the optic nerve and cause glaucoma, although glaucoma can sometimes occur even when the pressure is within the usual range.

Intraocular Tumor

A growth arising within the eye. It may be noncancerous or cancerous; examples include uveal melanoma in adults and retinoblastoma in children. It can affect vision or eye pressure.

Intraoperative

Occurring during a surgical operation, including monitoring, findings, complications, or treatment decisions made during the procedure.

Intraoperative Blood Transfusion

Blood or blood components given during surgery to replace major blood loss and maintain oxygen delivery. The decision depends on bleeding, symptoms, circulation, hemoglobin, and the person's medical condition.

Intraoperative Neuromonitoring

Electrical tests used during selected operations to

watch the function of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, or muscles. Signals can warn the surgical team about a possible change in nerve function, allowing them to reassess the procedure and protect nearby structures.

Intraoral

Located inside the mouth or performed through the mouth, such as an examination, scan, injection, or surgical procedure.

Intraosseous Access

Placement of a special needle into the inner part of a bone to give fluids, blood, or medicines when a vein cannot be reached quickly. It is temporary and can cause pain, leakage, infection, or bone injury.

Intraosseous Infusion

Giving fluids, blood, or medicine through a needle placed in the marrow space inside a bone. This route provides rapid access to the bloodstream when a vein cannot be reached quickly, especially in emergencies. The procedure can injure bone or nearby tissue or allow fluid to leak.

Alternate Names:
IO Access; Intraosseous Vascular Access

Intrapartum

The period during labor and childbirth, from the onset of regular uterine contractions leading to cervical dilation until delivery of the baby and placenta.

Intrapartum Fever

Fever during labor, which may result from infection, epidural analgesia, dehydration, or other causes and can affect the mother or fetus.

Intrapartum Stillbirth

Intrapartum stillbirth is fetal death occurring during labor after a live fetus was documented before labor, requiring obstetric investigation and support.

Intrapericardial

Located inside the pericardial sac, the thin membrane surrounding the heart. An intrapericardial mass or fluid collection may affect how the heart fills or beats.

Intraperitoneal

Intraperitoneal means within the peritoneal cavity or administered into it, including selected medicines, dialysis fluid, or procedures.

Intraperitonealroute

A route of treatment in which fluid or medicine is placed into the abdominal cavity. It is used for peritoneal dialysis and selected treatments and requires sterile technique to prevent infection.

Intraprostatic

Located within the prostate gland, describing a lesion, injection, infection, biopsy, procedure, or other finding centered inside prostate tissue.

Intrapulmonary

Located within lung tissue or occurring inside the lung's air spaces, blood vessels, or other structures. Intrapulmonary findings may represent normal anatomy, infection, fluid, bleeding, inflammation, or tumors.

Intrapulmonary Shunt

Blood flow through parts of the lungs that are not receiving enough air, so the blood cannot take up normal oxygen. It can occur with pneumonia, lung collapse, or severe lung injury and may cause low oxygen despite supplemental oxygen.

Intrasynovial

Intrasynovial means within the synovial lining or fluid-filled space of a joint or tendon sheath.

Intratendinous

Located within a tendon, describing a tear, calcium deposit, injection, degenerative change, or other abnormality affecting the tendon's substance.

Intratesticular

Located within testicular tissue. An intratesticular mass may be benign or malignant and is usually

evaluated with physical examination and scrotal ultrasound, interpreted in the clinical context.

Intrathecal

Intrathecal means within the fluid-filled space surrounding the brain and spinal cord; medicines may be given there by lumbar puncture.

Intrathecal Chemotherapy

Cancer medicine placed directly into the fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord, usually through a lumbar puncture or implanted reservoir. It is used for selected leukemias, lymphomas, or cancer spread to this fluid; infection, bleeding, headache, and nervous-system toxicity are possible.

Intrathoracic

Intrathoracic means within the chest cavity, including the lungs, heart, mediastinum, vessels, and thoracic lymph nodes.

Intrathoracic Localized Obstruction

A blockage within the chest affecting an airway, esophagus, or major blood vessel. Tumors, inhaled objects, scarring, or abnormal vessels may cause breathing difficulty, swallowing problems, chest pain, or reduced blood flow and require targeted testing.

Intratracheal

Intratracheal means within the trachea, such as a tube, medicine, foreign body, lesion, or route of administration.

Intratympanic

Intratympanic means delivered through the eardrum into the middle ear, often for selected inner-ear disorders or local treatment.

Intrauterine

Located or occurring within the uterus, including a pregnancy, device, medicine, lesion, or procedure. The term describes location and requires additional information to explain the finding's purpose, cause, or risk.

Intrauterine Adhesions

Bands of scar tissue inside the uterus, often forming after a uterine procedure or infection. They may cause no symptoms or lead to light or absent periods, pelvic pain, difficulty becoming pregnant, or pregnancy loss. Symptomatic adhesions are sometimes called Asherman syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Intrauterine Synechiae

Intrauterine Contraceptive Device

Alternate name; see *Intrauterine Device*.

Intrauterine Device

A small device placed inside the uterus to prevent pregnancy for several years while remaining reversible. Copper devices work without hormones; hormonal devices release a progestogen and often reduce menstrual bleeding. Rare risks include expulsion, perforation during insertion, and infection soon after placement.

Intrauterine Device Insertion

The clinical placement of a small, T-shaped contraceptive device (copper or levonorgestrel-releasing) into the uterine cavity through the cervix; see *Intrauterine Device*.

Intrauterine Devices

Alternate plural; see *Intrauterine Device*.

Intrauterine Fetal Demise

Fetal death occurring inside the uterus after reaching biological or statutory viability; see *Stillbirth*.

Intrauterine Fetal Demise / Stillbirth

Alternate wording; see *Fetal Death* and *Stillbirth*.

Intrauterine Growth Restriction

Older term; see *Fetal Growth Restriction*.

Intrauterine Insemination

A fertility procedure in which prepared sperm is placed directly into the uterus around ovulation. It is used for selected infertility causes and usually

depends on at least one open fallopian tube; risks include cramps, infection, and multiple pregnancy.

Intrauterine Infection

Bacterial or viral infection within the gestational cavity involving the amniotic fluid, placenta, or fetal membranes; see *Chorioamnionitis*.

Intrauterine Pressure Catheter

A thin tube placed inside the uterus during labor to measure contraction strength and timing more directly. It is used in selected situations when external monitoring does not provide enough information and can cause infection or injury.

Intrauterine System

A small T-shaped contraceptive device placed inside the uterus that slowly releases a progestogen hormone to prevent pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
IUS

Intrauterine Transfusion

A specialist procedure that gives compatible red blood cells to a fetus through the umbilical cord or, less often, the fetal abdomen. It treats severe fetal anemia and carries risks such as bleeding, infection, early labor, or fetal loss.

Intravascular

Intravascular means within a blood vessel, including a catheter, clot, injection, or process occurring in the circulation.

Intravascular Catheter Infections

Infections caused by microorganisms entering or growing on a catheter placed inside a blood vessel. They may produce fever, chills, low blood pressure, or bloodstream infection. Diagnosis uses examination and blood cultures, and treatment may require antibiotics and catheter removal.

Intravascular Echocardiography

Alternate name; see *Intravascular Ultrasound*.

Intravascular Filter

A small device placed in a large vein to catch clots traveling from the legs toward the lungs. It is used selectively when blood-thinning treatment cannot be given or has not worked adequately.

Intravascular Hemolysis

Destruction of red blood cells within the bloodstream, releasing hemoglobin into plasma; causes include immune hemolysis, mechanical trauma, infections, toxins, and transfusion reactions.

Intravascular Lymphoma

A rare, fast-growing blood cancer in which abnormal white blood cells collect inside small blood vessels. It may affect the skin, brain, or other organs, causing fever, skin changes, or neurologic problems.

Intravascular Ultrasound

An ultrasound test done from inside a blood vessel. A tiny ultrasound device on a catheter creates pictures of the vessel wall and any narrowing or fatty plaque, helping guide some treatments.

Alternate Names:
IVUS

Intravenous

Into or within a vein; intravenous medicines, fluids, or blood products are delivered directly into the bloodstream.

Intravenous Anesthesia

General anesthesia started or maintained with medicines given through a vein. It acts quickly; dose adjustment and continuous monitoring of breathing, blood pressure, heart rhythm, and recovery are part of its delivery.

Intravenous Catheters

Flexible devices inserted into a vein to deliver fluids, medicines, blood products, nutrition, or contrast, or to obtain blood samples; complications include infection, thrombosis, infiltration, and extravasation.

Intravenous Drip

Delivery of fluid, blood products, nutrients, or medicine directly into a vein through a catheter. The amount and speed are prescribed and monitored for reactions, fluid overload, infection, or vein irritation.

Alternate Names:
Intravenous Infusion

Intravenous Immunoglobulin

A purified preparation of pooled antibodies given through a vein (IVIg) for selected immune deficiencies, autoimmune diseases, inflammatory disorders, and some neurologic conditions.

Intravenous Leiomyomatosis

Extension of benign uterine smooth-muscle tumor into venous channels, sometimes reaching the inferior vena cava or right heart. Imaging is important because extensive disease can cause serious cardiovascular complications.

Intravenous Lipid Emulsion Therapy

Emergency treatment using a fat-containing fluid through a vein for selected severe poisonings, especially local-anesthetic toxicity that does not respond to initial treatment. It requires intensive monitoring; its exact mechanism is not fully understood.

Intravenous Pyelogram

An X-ray examination of the kidneys, ureters, and bladder after iodine-containing contrast is injected into a vein and passed into the urine. CT urography or ultrasound often provides this information today.

Intravenous Pyelography

Alternate name; see *Intravenous Pyelogram*.

Intravenous Sedation

Administration of sedative medicines through a vein to reduce anxiety, discomfort, or awareness during a procedure while maintaining appropriate monitoring and readiness to support breathing.

Intravenous Thrombolysis

Administration of a clot-dissolving medicine through a vein to restore blood flow in selected acute vascular conditions; see *Thrombolysis*.

Intraventricular Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the fluid-filled spaces inside the brain, especially in very premature newborns. The blood can block fluid flow and cause brain injury; ultrasound is used to detect and monitor it.

Intraventricular Hemorrhage Of The Newborn

Intraventricular hemorrhage in a newborn is bleeding into the brain's ventricular system, most often in premature infants, and can cause hydrocephalus or neurologic injury.

Intravesical Therapy

Treatment delivered directly into the bladder through a catheter. It is used for conditions such as some bladder cancers or interstitial cystitis and may cause bladder irritation or, less commonly, effects elsewhere in the body.

Intravitreal Injection

An eye procedure in which medicine is injected into the jelly-like center of the eye to treat retinal or macular disease. Temporary discomfort or floaters may occur; infection, bleeding, retinal detachment, and raised eye pressure are uncommon but serious risks.

Intrinsic

Belonging naturally to a structure or process and arising from within it, rather than being externally imposed.

Intrinsic Factor

A protein secreted by stomach parietal cells that is required for vitamin B12 absorption in the terminal ileum.

Intrinsic Pathway of Coagulation

One of the linked pathways that activates blood-

clotting proteins and helps form a clot. It involves clotting factors that activate factor X; the activated partial thromboplastin time (aPTT) is a laboratory test that assesses this pathway along with other parts of clotting.

Intrinsic Renal AKI

Sudden loss of kidney function caused by damage within the kidney itself. Causes include injury from medicines or toxins, inflammation, infection, poor blood supply, or immune disease.

Intrinsic Sphincter Deficiency

Weakness of the urinary sphincter that causes stress urinary incontinence.

Alternate Names:
ISD

Intrinsic Sympathomimetic Activity

The pharmacological property of certain beta-adrenergic receptor antagonist drugs (such as acebutolol and pindolol) that act as partial agonists, stimulating beta-receptors to a mild degree while simultaneously blocking endogenous catecholamines, resulting in less resting bradycardia.

Alternate Names:
ISA

Introducer Sheath

A short hollow tube placed in a blood vessel to provide access for catheters and other devices during an intravascular procedure.

Introitus

An entrance or opening, especially the entrance to the vagina.

Intron

A non-coding segment of a gene that is transcribed into RNA but spliced out before the messenger RNA is translated into a protein.

Intrusive Thought

An unwanted, distressing thought, image, or impulse that enters awareness repeatedly; it does not necessarily reflect intent or desire.

Intrusive Thoughts

Unwanted, involuntary, and distressing thoughts, images, or urges that suddenly enter consciousness; see *Intrusive Thought*.

Intubate

To place a tube into a body passage, especially an endotracheal tube through the mouth or nose into the trachea to maintain an airway or support ventilation.

Intubation

Placement of a tube into the airway or another body passage to maintain it or deliver treatment.

Intussusception

A serious medical condition in which one segment of the intestine slides or telescopes inside an adjacent segment, much like a folding collapsible telescope. This blocks food and fluid from passing through and pinches off the blood supply to the affected part of the bowel. It is the most common cause of intestinal blockage in infants and young children, classically causing sudden episodes of intense, cramping abdominal pain (where the child pulls their knees to the chest), vomiting, and reddish, jelly-like stools containing mucus and blood.

Alternate Names:
Intestinal Telescoping; Invagination of the Bowel

Inulin

Inulin is a plant fructan used as a dietary fiber and in tests of glomerular filtration because it is freely filtered and minimally handled by the kidney.

In Utero

Within the uterus before birth. The term describes a developing fetus or an event that occurs during pregnancy.

Invasive

Able to enter and spread through tissues; the term may describe an infection, tumor, procedure, or

disease that penetrates nearby structures.

Invasive Candidiasis

A serious Candida infection involving the bloodstream or deep organs, most often in people who are critically ill or have weakened immunity. It may cause persistent fever or signs of organ dysfunction.

Invasive Carcinoma Of No Special Type

The most common type of invasive breast cancer. The cancer cells have grown into surrounding breast tissue, and "no special type" means they lack features that define a more specific subtype.

Alternate Names:
Invasive Ductal Carcinoma; Invasive Ductal Carcinoma, NOS; IDC

Invasive Ductal Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Invasive Carcinoma Of No Special Type*.

Invasive Lobular Carcinoma

A breast cancer that begins in the milk-producing lobules and invades surrounding breast tissue. Its cells often grow in single-file patterns, which may make the cancer difficult to detect as a distinct lump.

Invasive Mechanical Ventilation

Breathing support delivered through a tube placed in the trachea. A ventilator moves air and oxygen into the lungs and removes carbon dioxide when a person cannot breathe adequately without support.

Invasive Mole

A hydatidiform mole that invades the uterine myometrium or vascular spaces; it is a form of gestational trophoblastic neoplasia and may persist or metastasize.

Invasive Procedure

A medical examination, test, or treatment that enters the body by piercing the skin or inserting an instrument, tube, needle, or camera into internal tissues or organs. Examples range from needle biopsies and endoscopy to open surgery. Possible risks include bleeding, infection, pain, tissue damage, and anesthesia complications.

Alternate Names:
Invasive Medical Procedure; Invasive Intervention

Inverse Agonist

A medicine that binds to a receptor and reduces its natural baseline activity, producing an effect opposite to that of an agonist. Its clinical effect depends on the receptor and the tissues where it is present.

Inverse Psoriasis

A morphological variant of plaque psoriasis that preferentially involves intertriginous and flexural anatomical regions (axillae, inframammary folds, inguinal creases, and intergluteal cleft), appearing as well-demarcated, smooth, glistening erythematous plaques without typical silvery scales due to maceration.

Alternate Names:
Flexural Psoriasis; Intertriginous Psoriasis

Inversion

A chromosome segment that has broken off and rejoined in the reverse direction. It often causes no health problem, but can affect health if the break disrupts a gene or interferes with reproduction.

Invert

To turn upside down, reverse, or turn inward; in anatomy, inversion can describe movement of the sole of the foot toward the midline.

Inverted Nipple

Alternate name; see *Nipple Inversion Or Retraction*.

Inverted Papilloma

A usually benign but locally destructive tumor arising most often in the nasal cavity or sinuses; it can recur and rarely become cancerous.

Invert Sugar

A mixture of glucose and fructose produced by

splitting sucrose, used as a sweetener in foods and medicines. It has nutritional effects similar to other added sugars and contributes to total carbohydrate and energy intake.

Investigational

Being studied in clinical research and not yet established as safe and effective for a particular use. Investigational medicines and devices require appropriate oversight, informed consent, and clear communication of uncertainty.

Inveterate

Long-standing, deeply established, or difficult to change, often describing a habit, condition, or behavior. The word indicates persistence but does not identify the cause, severity, treatment, or expected outcome.

In Vitro

In vitro means performed outside a living organism, such as in a test tube, culture dish, or laboratory system.

In Vitro Fertilisation

British spelling; see *In Vitro Fertilization*.

In Vitro Fertilization

A fertility treatment in which eggs are collected from the ovaries, fertilized with sperm in a laboratory, and an embryo is transferred to the uterus.

In Vivo

Taking place or being studied inside a living person, animal, or other organism. For example, an in vivo test examines how a medicine works in the body rather than only in a laboratory dish.

In-Vivo

Alternate spelling; see *In Vivo*.

Involucrum

An involucrum is a sheath of new bone that forms around dead bone, classically in chronic osteomyelitis.

Involuntary

Occurring without conscious control or deliberate choice, such as a reflex, autonomic function, or involuntary muscle movement.

Involuntary Movement

A non-volitional, spontaneous, purposeless motor activity resulting from functional disruption or neurodegenerative degeneration within the extrapyramidal motor system, basal ganglia (striatum, subthalamic nucleus, globus pallidus, substantia nigra), or cerebellar circuits. Classified into hyperkinetic movement disorders: tremor (rhythmic, oscillatory movement categorized into resting [Parkinson disease], action/postural [essential tremor], or intention [cerebellar]); chorea (rapid, non-stereotyped, dance-like jerky movements, as in Huntington disease and Sydenham chorea); athetosis (slow, writhing, twisting distal limb movements); hemiballismus (violent, large-amplitude flinging limb movements secondary to contralateral subthalamic nucleus stroke); dystonia (sustained muscle contractions resulting in twisting, repetitive posturing, such as torticollis or blepharospasm); myoclonus (sudden, brief, shock-like muscle jerks); and tics (repetitive, semi-voluntary, stereotyped movements or vocalizations preceded by a premonitory urge, hallmark of Tourette syndrome). Diagnostic evaluation incorporates electromyography, neuroimaging (MRI), genetic testing, and screening for metabolic or drug-induced etiologies (e.g., tardive dyskinesia from dopamine receptor antagonists).

Alternate Names:
Hyperkinetic Movement Disorders; Involuntary Motor Activity; Dyskinetic Movements

Involuntary Movements

Plural form; see *Involuntary Movement*.

Alternate Names:
Hyperkinetic Movement Disorders; Involuntary Motor Activity; Dyskinetic Movements

Involuntary Muscle

Muscle that contracts without conscious control, including smooth muscle in internal organs and cardiac muscle in the heart.

Involuntary Psychiatric Treatment

Assessment, hospitalization, or treatment without the patient's consent under applicable law when serious mental disorder creates a substantial risk of harm or severe inability to meet basic needs. The least restrictive alternative, due process, and ongoing reassessment are required.

Involute

To shrink, return toward a former size, or undergo involution; in anatomy, an involute structure may be tightly coiled or rolled inward.

Involution

The normal return of the uterus to its smaller, prepregnancy size after childbirth. This occurs gradually over several weeks as the uterine muscle contracts and the placental attachment heals.

Iodamoeba Butschlii

A usually non-disease-causing intestinal amoeba spread by swallowing cysts in contaminated food or water. Finding it in stool suggests fecal exposure but usually does not require treatment unless another infection is present.

Iodide

A form of the essential mineral iodine that carries a negative electrical charge, commonly found in iodized table salt, seafood, and dairy products. The thyroid gland absorbs iodide from the bloodstream and uses it as an indispensable raw material to produce thyroid hormones, which regulate the body's metabolism, growth, and development.

Iodide-Associated Sialadenitis

Swelling and inflammation of a salivary gland after exposure to a large amount of iodide, sometimes from a medicine or imaging contrast. It can cause painful swelling and dry mouth and usually improves when the cause is addressed.

Iodides

Plural form; see *Iodide*.

Iodinated Contrast Media

Iodine-containing substances injected for CT scans, angiography, X-rays, or fluoroscopy to make vessels and organs easier to see. They can cause allergic-like reactions, leakage into tissue, thyroid changes, or kidney injury in susceptible people.

Iodine

An essential mineral used to make thyroid hormones, which regulate growth, brain development, and metabolism. Too little iodine can cause thyroid enlargement and hormone deficiency, especially harmful during pregnancy and childhood; too much can also disturb thyroid function. Main sources include iodized salt, seafood, dairy, and some supplements.

Iodine-123

A radioactive form of iodine used mainly to create images of the thyroid. It gives off a type of radiation detected by a camera and generally exposes the body to less radiation than iodine-131.

Iodine-131

A radioactive form of iodine used mainly to diagnose or treat selected thyroid disorders. Thyroid cells absorb it, allowing targeted radiation, but exposure can affect other tissues and requires safety precautions.

Iodine Deficiency

Too little iodine in the diet. Because iodine is needed to make thyroid hormones, deficiency can cause thyroid enlargement and low thyroid function. Severe deficiency during pregnancy or childhood can impair growth and brain development.

Iodine Perfusion

The distribution of iodine-containing contrast through tissues or blood vessels, measured during imaging such as computed tomography or angiography. Contrast can rarely cause allergic reactions and may affect kidney or thyroid function.

Iodine Poisoning

Iodine poisoning follows excessive iodine exposure

and can irritate the gastrointestinal tract, disrupt thyroid function, and cause systemic toxicity depending on dose and formulation.

Iododerma

A skin eruption caused by excess iodine, often appearing as acne-like bumps or pus-filled spots on the face, arms, or legs. It usually improves after the iodine source is stopped under medical guidance.

Iodoform

A yellow iodine-containing compound formerly used as an antiseptic and in some wound or dental preparations. It can irritate tissue and cause toxicity if absorbed or swallowed and is now used only in selected contexts.

Iohexol

A water-soluble iodine-containing contrast medicine used during CT scans, angiography, and other imaging studies to make vessels and organs easier to see.

Ion

An atom or molecule that has gained or lost one or more electrons, giving it a positive or negative electrical charge. In the human body, dissolved ions—such as sodium, potassium, calcium, and chloride—are called electrolytes. They conduct tiny electrical currents across cell membranes that allow nerves to fire, muscles to contract, and cells to maintain proper water and chemical balance.

Ion Channel

A protein pore in a cell membrane that allows selected electrically charged particles, such as sodium, potassium, calcium, or chloride, to cross. Ion channels are important for nerve signals, muscle contraction, and secretion.

Ionization

The formation of charged particles by gaining or losing electrons or protons. A medicine's degree of ionization affects its solubility, membrane passage, absorption, distribution, and urinary excretion.

Ionized Calcium Test

A clinical laboratory assay measuring free (unbound), physiologically active calcium ions in serum or whole blood. It provides an accurate assessment of calcium homeostasis independent of serum albumin concentrations, particularly in critical illness, acid-base disorders, and parathyroid pathology.

Alternate Names:
Ionized Calcium; Free Calcium Test; Serum Free Calcium

Ionizing Radiation

Radiation with enough energy to remove electrons from atoms and create ions, including X-rays, gamma rays, and certain particulate emissions. It can cause deterministic tissue effects at sufficient doses and stochastic cancer risk at lower doses.

Ionophore

A molecule that transports ions across a lipid membrane. Ionophores have research, antimicrobial, and veterinary uses; some can disrupt human cellular ion balance and are toxic.

Ions

Plural form; see *Ion*.

Iontophoresis

Use of a mild electrical current to drive an ionized medicine through the skin or alter sweat-gland activity. It is used in selected dermatologic and rehabilitation settings; skin irritation and burns can occur.

Ion Transport

Movement of charged particles across a cell membrane through channels, carriers, or pumps. It maintains membrane potentials, nerve signaling, muscle contraction, fluid balance, and epithelial transport.

Iopamidol

A nonionic iodine-containing contrast medicine used to improve CT, angiography, and other medical images. It can cause warmth, nausea, allergy, kidney problems, or thyroid effects, so risks require assess-

ment beforehand.

Iothalamate Clearance

A specialized test of kidney filtration that measures how quickly injected iothalamate is removed from the blood, sometimes using timed urine samples. It is used when a more direct estimate of kidney function is needed.

Ioxaglic Acid

An older iodinated contrast medium used for radiographic imaging, including selected angiographic and urinary-tract studies. It has largely been superseded by newer agents, but its history is relevant when assessing prior contrast reactions.

IPC

Alternate name; see *Indwelling Pleural Catheter*.

Ipecac

A vomiting medicine formerly used after poisoning. Its use has largely been abandoned because vomiting can cause aspiration and delay more appropriate poisoning treatment.

Ipilimumab

An immunotherapy antibody that blocks CTLA-4, removing a brake on T cells so they can attack cancer. It can cause immune inflammation in the bowel, skin, liver, lungs, hormone glands, or other organs.

IPMN

Abbreviation; see *Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm*.

Ipratropium

Ipratropium is an inhaled short-acting muscarinic antagonist that reduces vagally mediated bronchoconstriction and nasal secretion; it is used in COPD and acute asthma with bronchodilators.

Ipratropium Bromide

An inhaled medicine that relaxes narrowed airways and reduces mucus production. It is used mainly for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease and, with other medicines, for severe asthma attacks. Dry mouth and blurred vision can occur.

Iproniazid

Iproniazid is an older monoamine oxidase inhibitor antidepressant that is no longer commonly used because of serious liver toxicity and drug interactions.

Ipsilateral

On or affecting the same side of the body as a stated structure or injury. For example, weakness in the right arm and right leg is ipsilateral to a finding on the right side of the body; the opposite term is contralateral.

IQ Testing

Standardized testing that estimates intellectual functioning by comparing performance on tasks such as reasoning, memory, language, and visual-spatial problem-solving with that of people of the same age. The score is one measure of ability and can be affected by language, education, sensory or motor limits, and the person's developmental stage.

Irbesartan

Irbesartan is an angiotensin-II receptor blocker used for hypertension and diabetic kidney disease; it can cause hyperkalaemia, hypotension, and renal-function changes and is contraindicated in pregnancy.

Iridium

Iridium is a dense metal whose radioactive isotopes, especially iridium-192, are used in industrial testing and some medical brachytherapy.

Iridocyclitis

Inflammation of both the iris and ciliary body, the structures at the front of the eye. It is a form of anterior uveitis and may cause pain, redness, light sensitivity, or blurred vision.

Iridodialysis

A traumatic or surgical separation or avulsion of

the iris root from its anatomical attachment to the ciliary body, producing a characteristic D-shaped eccentric pupil, monocular diplopia, photophobia, and an anterior chamber hyphema.

Iridodonesis

Shaking or trembling of the iris when the eye moves, often because the lens is absent or its supporting fibers are weak. An eye examination can identify the cause and related lens or eye problems.

Iridoschisis

A rare splitting of the iris tissue into layers, usually in older adults. It may be associated with glaucoma or corneal problems and is evaluated in relation to these conditions.

Iridotomy

A laser or surgical procedure that makes a small opening in the iris, allowing aqueous humor to pass between the posterior and anterior chambers and relieving pupillary block. It is used to treat or prevent selected forms of angle-closure glaucoma.

Irinotecan

A chemotherapy medicine that inhibits topoisomerase I and is used for colorectal and several other cancers.

Irinotecan Hydrochloride

A chemotherapy medicine that blocks topoisomerase I and damages cancer-cell DNA, used for selected cancers with diarrhea and low blood counts possible.

Iris

The colored, muscular ring between the cornea and lens that controls the size of the pupil and therefore the amount of light entering the eye. Its muscles constrict the pupil in bright light and enlarge it in dim light.

Iris Atrophy

Thinning or loss of iris tissue resulting from trauma, chronic inflammation, ischaemia, or neurodegenerative disease, leading to a translucent or patched iris appearance. It may be sectoral or diffuse and can be associated with decreased pupillary response, photophobia, or secondary glaucoma.

Iris Cyst

An iris cyst is a fluid-filled lesion on or within the iris, usually benign but sometimes affecting vision, pressure, or the appearance of the eye.

Iris Disease

A disorder of the colored part of the eye, including inflammation, injury, infection, developmental abnormalities, or tumors.

Iris Leiomyoma

A rare benign smooth-muscle tumor of the iris that may appear as a pigmented or nonpigmented mass. It can distort the pupil, impair vision, or resemble melanoma, so ophthalmic examination and imaging are needed.

Iris Melanoma

Iris melanoma is a malignant tumor of pigment cells in the iris and may appear as a growing pigmented lesion, pupil distortion, or glaucoma.

Iris Neoplasm

An iris neoplasm is an abnormal growth arising in the colored part of the eye; it may be benign or malignant and can affect vision or eye pressure.

Iris Prolapse

Protrusion of iris tissue through a corneal or scleral wound, most often after penetrating eye trauma or surgery. It may compromise the globe and is managed with urgent ophthalmic repair.

Iritis

Inflammation of the iris, the colored part of the eye. It is a form of anterior uveitis and may cause eye pain, redness, light sensitivity, or blurred vision.

Alternate Names:
Anterior Uveitis; Iridocyclitis

Iron

A mineral needed to make hemoglobin, the protein that carries oxygen in red blood cells, and to support muscles and cellular energy. Low iron may result from blood loss, poor intake, increased needs, or poor absorption.

Iron Deficiency

A shortage of iron needed to make hemoglobin and support normal cell function. It may result from blood loss, low intake, increased needs, or poor absorption and can cause tiredness, pale skin, shortness of breath, brittle nails, or unusual cravings.

Iron-Deficiency Anaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Iron Deficiency Anemia*.

Iron-Deficiency Anaemia In Adolescents

Iron-deficiency anaemia during adolescence, commonly related to rapid growth, inadequate dietary iron, or menstrual blood loss. Evaluation identifies contributing causes and informs dietary and medical treatment.

Iron Deficiency Anemia

The most common type of anemia, occurring when the body lacks sufficient iron to produce hemoglobin, the protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen to tissues. Without enough iron, red blood cells become abnormally small and pale, and cannot deliver adequate oxygen throughout the body. Common causes include chronic blood loss (such as heavy menstrual periods or slow bleeding in the digestive tract), poor dietary iron intake, or poor iron absorption, leading to fatigue, pale skin, weakness, dizziness, and cold hands and feet.

Alternate Names:
IDA

Iron-Deficiency Anemia

Alternate spelling; see *Iron Deficiency Anemia*.

Iron-Deficiency Anemia in Children

Iron-deficiency anemia in a child caused by too little iron, increased needs during growth, blood loss, or poor absorption. It reduces hemoglobin production and may cause pale skin, tiredness, irritability, poor concentration, or delayed development when severe or long-lasting.

Iron-Deficiency Anemia in Young Children

Iron-deficiency anemia in an infant or toddler caused by too little iron, rapid growth, excessive cow's milk intake, blood loss, or poor absorption. It may cause pale skin, tiredness, irritability, poor appetite, or developmental problems when severe or long-lasting.

Iron Overdose

Poisoning after taking too much iron, especially from supplements. It can cause vomiting, abdominal pain, internal bleeding, severe acid imbalance, shock, liver failure, and death.

Iron Overload

Excess iron stored in the body, which can damage the liver, heart, pancreas, joints, or endocrine organs.

Iron Overload Anemia

Anemia associated with excess iron accumulation, often in disorders such as sideroblastic anemia or repeated transfusion; see *Iron Overload* and *Sideroblastic Anemia*.

Iron Studies

A group of blood tests used to assess iron availability and storage, commonly including serum iron, ferritin, transferrin or total iron-binding capacity, and transferrin saturation. Results help distinguish iron deficiency, inflammation-related changes, and iron overload.

Iron Toxicity

Poisoning from too much iron, often after swallowing iron tablets. Early effects can include vomiting, abdominal pain, and intestinal bleeding; severe poisoning can lead to shock, liver failure, or coma.

Irradiated Foods

Irradiated foods are exposed to controlled ionizing radiation to reduce pathogens, insects, or spoilage; the process does not make food radioactive.

Irradiation

Exposure to or treatment with radiation; irradiation may be used diagnostically or therapeutically, or may cause tissue injury depending on dose and type.

Irradiation Fibrosis

Late-stage irreversible soft-tissue, pulmonary, or visceral scarring, collagen deposition, and microvascular obliterative endarteritis resulting from ionizing therapeutic radiation injury, mediated by sustained transforming growth factor-beta (TGF-beta) activation.

Irregular

Not following the usual pattern, rhythm, shape, timing, or order. In medicine, it may describe an uneven heartbeat, an unpredictable menstrual cycle, an unusual skin edge, or a result that does not match the expected pattern.

Irregular Menstrual Periods

Alternate name; see *Irregular Menstruation*.

Irregular Menstruation

Menstrual bleeding that is unusually early, late, frequent, infrequent, prolonged, heavy, or unpredictable for the person's age and reproductive context. Causes include pregnancy, ovulatory disorders, endocrine disease, medicines, structural lesions, and perimenopause.

Irregular Respiration

An abnormal breathing pattern in rate, depth, rhythm, or pauses. It may occur with sleep disorders, metabolic disturbance, lung disease, drug effects, or neurologic injury and may be accompanied by cyanosis or reduced consciousness.

Irregular Sleep-Wake Syndrome

A sleep disorder in which sleep and wakefulness occur in several poorly timed periods throughout the day and night instead of one regular nighttime sleep. It is more common with brain disease, dementia, aging, or limited exposure to daylight and daily routines.

Irreversible Cell Injury

Damage so severe that a cell cannot recover and eventually dies. It may follow prolonged lack of oxygen, poisoning, infection, heat, or other injury and can lead to loss of function in the affected tissue.

Irrigate

To wash or flush a body part, wound, cavity, or medical device with a fluid to remove debris, contaminants, or secretions.

Irrigation

Flushing a wound, body cavity, or organ with fluid to remove blood, debris, microorganisms, or unwanted material.

Irrigation Solution

A sterile or appropriately prepared liquid used to wash a wound, body cavity, organ, or surgical field. Solutions vary by tissue and procedure; contamination, pressure injury, electrolyte shifts, or chemical irritation can cause harm.

Irritability

An increased tendency to become annoyed, impatient, angry, or easily upset. It may occur with stress, sleep loss, pain, mood disorders, substance use, medicines, infection, or other medical conditions.

Irritable Bowel Syndrome

A disorder of gut–brain interaction that causes repeated abdominal pain and changes in bowel movements, such as diarrhea, constipation, or both. Pain is often related to passing stool and may occur with bloating or a feeling that the bowel has not emptied completely. IBS may be mainly constipation (IBS-C), mainly diarrhea (IBS-D), or a mixture of both (IBS-M). The gut may be unusually sensitive or its muscles may move food too quickly or too

slowly. Unlike inflammatory bowel disease, IBS does not cause visible damage or disease in the digestive tract.

Alternate Names:
IBS

Irritable Bowel Syndrome Diet

An eating plan adapted to reduce symptoms of irritable bowel syndrome while maintaining adequate nutrition. It may include a short trial of reducing fermentable carbohydrates followed by gradual food reintroduction.

Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS)

Alternate name; see *Irritable Bowel Syndrome*.

Irritable Mood

A mood marked by increased sensitivity, impatience, anger, or a tendency to become upset easily.

Irritant Contact Dermatitis

Inflammation of the skin caused by direct chemical or physical injury rather than an immune-mediated allergy. It commonly produces redness, burning, scaling, fissures, or pain at the area of exposure.

Irritant Contact Vaginitis

Vaginal or vulvar irritation caused by direct contact with an irritating substance, such as soap, douches, creams, or lubricants. It is not an infection or an allergy and may cause burning, soreness, redness, or swelling.

Irritants

Substances that inflame or damage tissues and cause symptoms without necessarily triggering a true immune allergy. Examples include smoke, chemicals, soaps, fumes, and pollutants affecting skin, eyes, airways, or digestion.

Irritation

A local unpleasant or inflammatory response to mechanical, chemical, thermal, infectious, or allergic stimuli. It may cause redness, itching, burning, pain, cough, or tearing depending on the tissue involved.

Isaacs Syndrome

A rare peripheral nerve hyperexcitability disorder causing continuous muscle-fibre activity, stiffness, cramps, fasciculations, myokymia, and delayed muscle relaxation. It may be autoimmune, paraneoplastic, or associated with inherited or acquired peripheral-nerve disorders.

Isavuconazole

An antifungal medicine used for selected serious infections, including invasive aspergillosis and mucormycosis. It blocks production of a substance fungi need for their cell membranes and can cause liver problems or medicine interactions.

Isazophos

Isazophos is an organophosphate pesticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

Ischaemia

Inadequate blood flow and oxygen delivery to a tissue, usually because of narrowed or blocked blood vessels, causing dysfunction or injury.

Ischaemic Heart Disease

Heart disease caused by reduced blood supply to the heart muscle, usually as a result of coronary artery disease; it may cause angina or myocardial infarction.

Ischemia

Reduced blood flow causing too little oxygen for a tissue's needs. It can cause pain, impaired function, permanent injury, or tissue death and may affect the heart, brain, limbs, or bowel.

Ischemia-Reperfusion Injury

Damage that can occur when blood flow returns to tissue that has been deprived of oxygen. The returning blood can trigger inflammation and cell injury, affecting the heart, brain, limbs, or transplanted organs.

Ischemic Bone Necrosis

Alternate name; see *Avascular Necrosis*.

Ischemic Cardiomyopathy

Weakening of the heart muscle caused by long-term reduced blood flow or previous heart attacks from coronary artery disease. Scarring can reduce pumping ability and increase the risk of heart failure and dangerous rhythms.

Ischemic Cascade

The chain of cell changes that occurs when tissue receives too little blood and oxygen. Cells lose energy, their normal balance of salts and water breaks down, and they may swell, become damaged, and die if blood flow is not restored.

Ischemic Chest Pain

Chest pain or discomfort caused by inadequate blood flow and oxygen to the heart muscle; also called angina. It may occur with narrowed coronary arteries, coronary artery spasm, or disease of the small coronary vessels. Symptoms may occur during exertion or at rest, and some people experience breathlessness or other discomfort instead of pain.

Ischemic Cholangiopathy

Damage to the bile ducts caused by inadequate blood flow, usually through the hepatic artery. It can cause bile-duct injury, bile blockage, repeated cholangitis, or narrowing of several bile ducts. It is especially important after liver transplantation or injury to the hepatic artery.

Ischemic Colitis

Inflammation and injury of the colon caused by reduced blood flow. It often causes sudden abdominal pain, bloody diarrhea, or rectal bleeding and commonly affects areas such as the splenic flexure.

Alternate Names:
Colon Ischemia; Ischemic Bowel Disease of the Colon

Ischemic Fasciitis

A noncancerous mass-like reaction in deep soft tissue caused by pressure and reduced blood flow, usually over a bony area in a person who is frail or has limited mobility. It can resemble a sarcoma on examination or imaging.

Ischemic Gangrene

Death of tissue after a prolonged severe loss of blood supply, most often in a toe, foot, finger, or leg. The tissue may become cold, numb, and black, with risk of infection.

Ischemic Heart Disease

Heart disease caused by inadequate blood flow through narrowed or blocked coronary arteries. It may cause chest pressure, breathlessness, heart attack, rhythm problems, heart failure, or sudden death.

Alternate Names:
Coronary artery disease; coronary heart disease

Ischemic Hepatitis

Widespread liver-cell injury caused by too little blood flow or oxygen. It commonly occurs with severe heart failure, very low blood pressure, respiratory failure, or severe infection. Liver enzymes usually rise suddenly and greatly. Despite its name, it is mainly liver-cell injury rather than inflammation.

Ischemic Necrosis of Bone

Bone death caused by inadequate blood supply, also called osteonecrosis or avascular necrosis; see *Avascular Necrosis*.

Ischemic Optic Neuropathy

Damage to the optic nerve caused by reduced blood flow, often producing sudden, usually painless vision loss. It may be arteritic or non-arteritic; older adults may also have headache, jaw pain, or scalp tenderness.

Ischemic Preconditioning

An intrinsic cardioprotective phenomenon in which brief, sub-lethal episodes of myocardial ischemia and reperfusion render the myocardium resistant to subsequent prolonged, potentially lethal ischemic insult, significantly reducing ultimate infarct size.

Ischemic Priapism

Alternate name; see *Priapism*.

Ischemic Stroke

The most common type of stroke, accounting for the vast majority of cases. It occurs when a blood clot or fatty plaque blocks or severely narrows an artery supplying blood to the brain. Deprived of oxygen and vital nutrients, brain cells in the affected area begin to die within minutes. Common signs develop suddenly and include numbness or weakness on one side of the face or body, difficulty speaking or understanding speech, vision loss, confusion, and loss of balance.

Alternate Names:
Cerebral Infarction; Ischemic Cerebrovascular Accident (CVA)

Ischiorectal Abscess

A deep perianal suppurative infection occupying the ischioanal (ischiorectal) fossa between the anal sphincter complex and the obturator internus muscle, typically arising from an infected cryptoglandular anal gland and presenting with severe throbbing perianal pain, induration, and systemic fever requiring surgical incision and drainage.

Alternate Names:
Ischioanal Abscess; Deep Perianal Abscess

Ischium

The lower, back part of each hip bone. Its rounded lower area bears weight when sitting, and nearby parts provide attachment for the hamstring muscles and other pelvic structures.

Ishak Score

A scoring system used on a liver biopsy to describe inflammation and scarring, especially in chronic hepatitis. Higher scores generally indicate more extensive damage; interpretation also depends on other tests and the person's history.

Islet Cell

A cell in a pancreatic islet that helps control blood glucose; beta cells make insulin and alpha cells make glucagon.

Islet Cell Cancer

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumors*.

Islets Of Langerhans

Small clusters of hormone-producing cells in the pancreas that release insulin, glucagon, and other hormones regulating blood sugar and metabolism.

Isoaminile

Isoaminile is an older sympathomimetic appetite suppressant that is no longer widely used because of cardiovascular and other adverse effects.

Isoantibodies

Antibodies made against antigens from another individual of the same species, such as antibodies involved in blood-group incompatibility.

Isoantigen

An antigen that differs between individuals of the same species and can trigger an immune response after exposure.

Isocarboxazid

Isocarboxazid is a monoamine oxidase inhibitor used for depression; it has important interactions with other medicines and tyramine-rich foods.

Isochromosomes

Abnormal chromosomes with two identical arms caused by division across the wrong axis of the centromere.

Isocitrate Dehydrogenase

An enzyme involved in how cells produce energy. Changes in the IDH1 or IDH2 genes can alter this enzyme and are found in some brain tumors, blood cancers, and other tumors, helping guide diagnosis and treatment.

Isocyanate

A reactive chemical group found in some industrial products; exposure can irritate the airways and cause occupational asthma or skin reactions.

Isoelectric Point

The acidity level at which a molecule, especially a protein, has no overall electrical charge. This property affects how the molecule dissolves and moves in laboratory tests.

Isoenzyme

One of several forms of an enzyme that catalyze the same chemical reaction but differ in structure, location, or regulation. Measuring selected isoenzymes can help identify the tissue affected by injury.

Isofenphos

A poisonous organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness because it disrupts nerve signals.

Isoflurane

Isoflurane is an inhaled anesthetic used to maintain general anesthesia; it can lower blood pressure and depress breathing.

Isogeneic Graft

A transplant between genetically identical individuals, such as identical twins, so immune rejection risk is relatively low.

Isohemagglutinins

Naturally occurring IgM antibodies present in human serum directed against ABO blood group carbohydrate antigens that are absent on the individual's own red blood cells (anti-A in group B, anti-B in group A, and both in group O), responsible for acute ABO-incompatible hemolytic transfusion reactions.

Isokinetic Exercise

Exercise in which a machine keeps a joint moving at a set speed while the muscles provide resistance. It is used mainly to measure or build strength during rehabilitation.

Isolate

To separate a person, organism, tissue, or substance from others; infection-control isolation separates people who may transmit a pathogen.

Isolated Systolic Hypertension

Elevated systolic blood pressure with normal diastolic pressure, commonly related to arterial stiffness in older adults and associated with increased cardiovascular risk.

Isolation

Separating a person with a contagious infection from others to limit spread, using appropriate rooms, protective equipment, and infection-control procedures.

Isolation Precautions

Measures used with standard precautions to reduce transmission of infection. Additional precautions may be contact, droplet, or airborne, depending on the mode of spread.

Isoleucine

An essential amino acid obtained from food that helps build proteins, support energy production, maintain muscle, and repair body tissues.

Isoleucine 33 Amyloidosis

A rare hereditary transthyretin amyloidosis variant involving an isoleucine substitution at position 33; clinical features depend on whether nerve, heart, or other organs are affected.

Isomerase

An enzyme that rearranges atoms within a molecule to form an isomer. Isomerases participate in metabolism, and inherited defects in related pathways can cause metabolic disease.

Isometric

Describing muscle contraction that produces force without a meaningful change in muscle length or joint movement.

Isometropia

The condition in which both eyes have approximately equal refractive power, so neither eye has

substantially more near-sightedness, far-sightedness, or astigmatism than the other.

Isoniazid

Isoniazid is a first-line antituberculous drug that inhibits mycolic-acid synthesis in Mycobacterium tuberculosis; hepatotoxicity and peripheral neuropathy are important risks, and pyridoxine is often given.

Isoniazid Toxicity

Harm from excessive or unusual sensitivity to isoniazid, especially liver injury, nerve damage, or seizures. Treatment may include vitamin B6, supportive care, activated charcoal, and seizure control.

Isoprenaline

Alternate name; see *Isoproterenol*.

Isoprocarb

Isoprocarb is a carbamate insecticide that can cause cholinergic poisoning if swallowed or absorbed in a significant amount.

Isopropanol Alcohol Poisoning

Poisoning from isopropanol, often found in rubbing alcohol, causing intoxication, vomiting, abdominal pain, low blood pressure, and sometimes coma.

Isopropyl Alcohol

A volatile alcohol used as a disinfectant and solvent. Ingestion can cause rapid intoxication, vomiting, abdominal pain, hypotension, and coma; management is supportive and differs from treatment of methanol or ethylene-glycol poisoning.

Isoproterenol

A beta-adrenergic medicine that increases heart rate and cardiac output. It is used in selected settings, such as certain severe slow heart rhythms; its effects on the heart and blood vessels limit its use.

Isosorbide

Isosorbide is a nitrate medicine that relaxes blood vessels and is used mainly to prevent or relieve angina; headache and low blood pressure are common adverse effects.

Isosorbide Dinitrate

A nitrate medicine that widens blood vessels and reduces the heart's workload. It is used mainly to prevent angina attacks; headache, dizziness, and low blood pressure may occur, and it can interact dangerously with erectile-dysfunction medicines.

Isospora

An older name for a group of intestinal coccidian parasites, now generally classified as Cystoisospora. Infection can cause watery diarrhea, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Isospora Belli

The former name for Cystoisospora belli, a parasite spread by swallowing oocysts in contaminated food or water. It causes watery diarrhea, cramps, nausea, and weight loss and can be severe or prolonged in immunocompromised people.

Isosporiasis

Older name for Cystoisosporiasis, an intestinal infection caused by the parasite Cystoisospora belli.

Iso-Sulfan Blue

A blue dye used to map lymphatic drainage or identify sentinel lymph nodes during selected surgical procedures.

Isotonic

Describing muscle contraction in which muscle length changes to move a joint under a relatively constant external load.

Isotonic Exercise

Exercise in which muscles change length while producing force against a relatively constant load, as in lifting or lowering a weight.

Isotonic Solution

A solution with an effective osmotic concentration close to that of plasma, such as normal saline or

balanced crystalloid. Isotonic fluids may expand extracellular volume; effects depend on the amount and can include fluid overload or electrolyte disturbance.

Isotope

One of two or more atoms of the same element with the same number of protons but different numbers of neutrons.

Isotretinoin

A vitamin-A-related medicine used for severe acne that has not improved with other treatment. It reduces skin-oil production and clogged pores but can cause birth defects, so pregnancy prevention and regular medical monitoring are essential.

Isovaleric Acidemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly break down the amino acid leucine. Harmful substances build up and may cause poor feeding, vomiting, unusual sleepiness, low muscle tone, or a sweaty-feet odor, especially during illness or fasting. Newborn screening can detect it; treatment uses a controlled diet and prevents prolonged fasting.

Alternate Names:
IVA; Isovaleryl-CoA Dehydrogenase Deficiency

Isovolumetric Contraction

The early phase of cardiac ventricular systole lasting from the closure of the atrioventricular (mitral and tricuspid) valves to the opening of the semilunar (aortic and pulmonic) valves, during which ventricular pressure rises steeply at a constant ventricular volume without ejection of blood.

Alternate Names:
Isovolumic Contraction Phase

Isozyme

One of several molecular forms of an enzyme that catalyze the same reaction but differ in structure, tissue distribution, or regulation.

Ispaghula Husk

Ispaghula husk, or psyllium, is a soluble fiber that absorbs water and helps regulate stool consistency; insufficient fluid can cause difficulty swallowing or intestinal blockage.

Isradipine

Isradipine is a calcium-channel blocker used to lower blood pressure; it may cause flushing, headache, ankle swelling, or dizziness.

ISUP Grade Group

A five-level system that grades prostate cancer by how abnormal the cancer looks under a microscope. Group 1 is the lowest risk, usually with a Gleason score of 6 or less. Groups 2 and 3 represent intermediate risk, while groups 4 and 5 represent high or highest risk. The result helps guide monitoring, surgery, radiation, or other treatment.

Alternate Names:
Grade Group; ISUP Prostate Grading System; WHO/ISUP Grade Group

Itch

An unpleasant skin sensation that creates the urge to scratch. It may be localized or widespread and can result from skin disease, allergy, infection, medicines, nerve disorders, or illnesses affecting organs such as the liver or kidneys.

Alternate Names:
Pruritus

Itching

Alternate name; see *Itch*.

Itchy Ear

An itching sensation of the external ear or ear canal, which may result from dermatitis, allergy, infection, dryness, or irritation from objects placed in the ear.

Itchy Skin

Alternate name; see *Itch*.

Iterative Reconstruction

A computer method that repeatedly improves medical images by comparing calculated results with measured scan data. It can reduce image noise

and sometimes allow lower radiation exposure, but usually requires more processing time.

ITP

Abbreviation; see *Immune Thrombocytopenia*.

Itraconazole

Itraconazole is a triazole antifungal that inhibits fungal ergosterol synthesis and treats several superficial and systemic mycoses; absorption, extensive drug interactions, liver injury, and negative inotropic effects require attention.

IUCD

An intrauterine contraceptive device, usually referring to an intrauterine device placed in the uterus to prevent pregnancy.

Ivabradine

Ivabradine slows the heart rate by acting on the sinus node and is used for selected patients with chronic heart failure or stable angina.

IVC Filter

A small device placed in the body's large lower vein to catch clots traveling from the legs to the lungs. It is used selectively when blood thinners cannot be used or have not prevented clots; blockage, movement, or vessel injury can occur.

Ivermectin

An antiparasitic medicine used for selected worm and mite infections, including strongyloidiasis, onchocerciasis, and scabies, when prescribed appropriately.

IVF

Abbreviation for *In Vitro Fertilization*.

IV Fluids

Fluids given through a vein to replace lost water and salts, support circulation, or provide maintenance during illness. The type and amount depend on the person's blood pressure, kidney and heart function, electrolytes, and cause of fluid loss.

IV Treatment At Home

Intravenous treatment given outside a hospital, usually through a catheter with instructions for safe infusion, line care, monitoring, and follow-up.

Ixabepilone

Ixabepilone is a chemotherapy medicine used for some advanced breast cancers; important risks include nerve damage, low blood counts, and allergic reactions.

Ixodes

A genus of hard ticks, including the ticks that transmit Lyme disease and several other infections. A bite may be painless; removing the tick promptly reduces, but does not eliminate, infection risk.

J

Jaccoud Arthropathy

A chronic, usually nonerosive deforming arthropathy, often affecting the hands, in which deformities such as ulnar deviation can be partly corrected by passive movement. It is associated with systemic lupus erythematosus and may follow rheumatic fever; similar deformities can occur in other disorders.

Jaccoud's Arthropathy

Alternate name; see *Jaccoud Arthropathy*.

Jack-In-The-Pulpit Poisoning

Jack-in-the-pulpit poisoning follows ingestion of calcium oxalate crystals from the plant, causing intense burning and swelling of the mouth, throat, and gastrointestinal tract.

Jackknife Position

A face-down position used during some operations in which the table is bent at the hips. The buttocks are raised while the head and legs are lower, improving access to the rectal, anal, or posterior pelvic regions.

Alternate Names:
Kraske Position

Jacksonian Epilepsy

Alternate name; see *Jacksonian March*.

Alternate Names:
Jacksonian March

Jacksonian March

A focal motor seizure in which twitching or jerking starts in one part of the body and spreads to nearby parts, such as from a finger up the arm. The spread reflects seizure activity moving across nearby areas of the brain's motor region. Awareness may remain intact.

Alternate Names:
Focal Motor March

Jacksonian Seizure

Alternate name; see *Jacksonian March*.

Jacobsen Syndrome

A rare chromosome condition caused by loss of part of chromosome 11. It may cause low platelets, unusual facial features, heart defects, bleeding, and developmental delay.

Alternate Names:
11q Terminal Deletion Syndrome; Jacobsen Deletion Disorder

Jadassohn-Lewandowsky Syndrome

A form of pachyonychia congenita, an inherited condition causing very thick, abnormal nails, painful thick skin on the palms and soles, and sometimes white patches in the mouth or rough bumps around hair follicles.

Alternate Names:
Pachyonychia Congenita Type 1; PC-1

Jadassohn's Naevus

A congenital skin hamartoma involving the epidermis, hair follicles, sebaceous glands, and other skin structures. It often appears as a smooth, yellowish, hairless patch or plaque on the scalp or face and may thicken around puberty; secondary tumors can occasionally arise.

Jaffe-Lichtenstein Syndrome

An older term for polyostotic fibrous dysplasia with café-au-lait skin pigmentation but without endocrine hyperfunction. In this bone disorder, abnormal fibrous tissue replaces normal bone at multiple sites, which may weaken, deform, or cause pain in the affected bones. When endocrine hyperfunction is also present, the condition is generally classified within McCune-Albright syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Polyostotic Fibrous Dysplasia; Jaffe-Lichtenstein Disease

JAK2

Janus kinase 2, an essential protein inside cells that helps transmit chemical signals from hormones and growth factors outside the cell to the cell's nucleus. It is especially critical for signaling the bone marrow to produce red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets. An acquired mutation in the extitJAK2 gene causes the switch to stay permanently turned on, leading to the uncontrolled overproduction of blood cells seen in myeloproliferative disorders such as polycythemia vera.

Jakob-Creutzfeldt Disease

Alternate name; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease*.

Jakob's Disease

Alternate name; see *Creutzfeldt-Jakob Disease*.

JAK-STAT Pathway

A conserved, rapid intracellular signal transduction cascade that directly couples the binding of extracellular polypeptide cytokines, interferons, interleukins, and colony-stimulating factors to transmembrane receptors with downstream nuclear gene transcription, bypassing second messengers. The pathway comprises three fundamental components: (1) Cell surface receptors lacking intrinsic enzymatic kinase activity (such as cytokine receptor families for erythropoietin, thrombopoietin, growth hormone, prolactin, interferons, and interleukins); (2) Janus Kinases (JAKs: JAK1, JAK2, JAK3, and TYK2), receptor-associated cytoplasmic non-receptor tyrosine kinases; and (3) Signal Transducers and Activators of Transcription (STATs: STAT1, STAT2, STAT3, STAT4, STAT5a, STAT5b, and STAT6), latent cytoplasmic transcription factors containing SH2 (Src homology 2) domains. Upon ligand binding, receptor multimerization brings receptor-bound JAKs into close apposition, triggering transphosphorylation and activation; activated JAKs phosphorylate specific tyrosine residues on the receptor's cytoplasmic tail, creating docking sites for the SH2 domains of STAT proteins. JAKs subsequently phosphorylate STAT monomers on a conserved C-terminal tyrosine residue, driving STAT dissociation from the receptor and spontaneous SH2-mediated homo- or heterodimerization. Activated STAT dimers translocate rapidly into the cell nucleus, where they bind specific DNA promoter sequences to regulate transcriptional programs governing hematopoiesis, cellular proliferation, survival, and immune differentiation. Regulated by negative feedback proteins including Suppressors of Cytokine Signaling (SOCS) and Protein Inhibitors of Activated STAT (PIAS). Dysregulation, constitutive hyperactivation, or somatic activating mutations in JAK-STAT signaling are implicated in myeloproliferative neoplasms (notably the *JAK2* V617F mutation), autoimmune diseases, and immunodeficiencies. Pharmacologic inhibitors (JAK inhibitors, "jakinibs"; such as ruxolitinib, tofacitinib, baricitinib, and upadacitinib) are therapeutic mainstays in rheumatology, dermatology, and hematology.

Jammed Finger

A finger injury caused by sudden force, often involving a sprain, joint dislocation, fracture, or tendon injury. It may cause pain, swelling, deformity, or difficulty moving the finger.

Janeway Lesions

Small, usually painless red or purple spots on the palms or soles associated with infective endocarditis, an infection of the heart lining or valves. They are traditionally linked to tiny infected emboli and differ from the often painful Osler nodes.

Jansen Disease

Alternate name; see *Jansen Metaphyseal Chondrodysplasia*.

Jansen Metaphyseal Chondrodysplasia

A rare autosomal dominant skeletal disorder caused by activating variants in *PTH1R*. It causes short-limb short stature, metaphyseal bone abnormalities, joint swelling, and often hypercalcemia, hypercalciuria, or nephrocalcinosis.

Janus Kinase

One of a family of proteins inside cells that pass signals from hormones and immune chemicals. Janus kinases help control inflammation, blood-cell production, and immune responses.

Janus Kinase Inhibitors

Medicines that block Janus kinase proteins and reduce certain immune signals. They are used for selected inflammatory and blood disorders, but can increase the risk of infections, blood clots, and other serious effects.

Japanese B Encephalitis

Alternate name; see *Japanese Encephalitis*.

Japanese Encephalitis

A viral infection spread by mosquitoes that can inflame the brain. Most infections cause no symptoms, but severe illness can cause fever, confusion, seizures, movement problems, or lasting disability.

Jarcho-Levin Syndrome

A historical term for congenital segmentation defects of the vertebrae and abnormalities of the ribs, usually referring to spondylocostal dysostosis. It has also been applied to spondylothoracic dysostosis, a distinct condition, so the specific diagnosis should be named when known.

Jargon Aphasia

A type of language disorder in which speech is fluent but filled with made-up words, incorrect sounds, or sentences that are hard to understand. Understanding spoken or written language is also impaired.

Alternate Names:
Neologistic Aphasia; Word Salad Speech

Jarisch-Herxheimer Reaction

An acute, self-limiting systemic inflammatory response that classically occurs within 2 to 24 hours following the initiation of effective antimicrobial therapy for spirochetal infections, most commonly primary or secondary syphilis treated with intramuscular penicillin G benzathine, as well as tick-borne relapsing fever (*Borrelia hermsii*), Lyme disease (*Borrelia burgdorferi* treated with doxycycline), and leptospirosis (*Leptospira interrogans*). Pathogenesis is driven by the rapid, massive lysis of abundant spirochetes upon antibiotic exposure, precipitating the abrupt release of spirochetal lipoproteins, endotoxin-like glycolipids, and pathogen-associated molecular patterns (PAMPs) into the systemic circulation. This triggers rapid activation of mononuclear phagocytes via Toll-like receptors (TLR2 and TLR4), inducing an explosive transient surge of pro-inflammatory cytokines, predominantly tumor necrosis factor-alpha (TNF-α), interleukin-6 (IL-6), and interleukin-8 (IL-8). Clinical manifestations include abrupt onset of high-grade fever, shaking chills (rigors), tachycardia, flushing, diaphoresis, headache, myalgias, arthralgias, transient hypotension, and acute exacerbation of pre-existing cutaneous syphilitic lesions. In pregnancy, it can provoke uterine contractions, fetal distress, or premature labor. Differentiated from a drug hypersensitivity reaction by the absence of urticaria, angioedema, or wheezing. Management is supportive with antipyretics (acetaminophen, NSAIDs) and intravenous hydration; antimicrobial therapy should be completed without discontinuation.

Jatene Procedure

An operation for babies born with the major arteries leaving the wrong heart chambers. The aorta and pulmonary artery are switched, and the coronary arteries are reattached.

Alternate Names:
Arterial Switch Operation; ASO

Jaundice

A yellowing of the skin, whites of the eyes (sclerae), and mucous membranes caused by high levels of bilirubin, a yellowish waste pigment produced when the body breaks down old red blood cells. The liver

normally processes bilirubin and excretes it into bile. Jaundice develops when the liver is inflamed or damaged, when bile ducts are blocked (such as by gallstones or a tumor), or when red blood cells break down faster than normal.

Alternate Names:
Icterus; Hyperbilirubinemia

Jaundice And Breastfeeding

Jaundice in a breastfed newborn may reflect low milk intake in the first days after birth, called suboptimal-intake hyperbilirubinemia, or persist despite adequate intake and weight gain, called breastmilk jaundice. Both usually involve unconjugated bilirubin, but have different timing and causes.

Jaundice Causes

Alternate topic; see *Jaundice*.

Jaundice In Adults

Yellowing of the skin or eyes in an adult from increased bilirubin. Causes include red-cell breakdown, liver injury, impaired bile flow, or inherited conditions. Dark urine, pale stool, abdominal pain, fever, confusion, or rapid onset may occur.

Jaundice In Neonates

Alternate name; see *Jaundice In Newborns*.

Jaundice In Newborns

Yellowing of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by increased bilirubin. It is often temporary, but severe hyperbilirubinemia can cause acute bilirubin encephalopathy and permanent brain injury (kernicterus).

Jaundice in Newborns (Hyperbilirubinemia)

Alternate name; see *Jaundice In Newborns*.

Jaw

The upper and lower bony structures of the mouth—the maxilla and mandible—which support the teeth and contribute to chewing, speech, facial shape, and the oral airway.

Jaw Fracture

A break in the lower jawbone or upper jawbone, usually after a blow to the face. Signs may include pain, swelling, loose teeth, numbness, a changed bite, or difficulty opening the mouth. Severe breaks can block the airway, especially when the lower jaw is broken in the front on both sides.

Jaw Jerk Reflex

A brief closing movement of the jaw when the chin is tapped with the mouth slightly open. An unusually strong response may suggest a problem in the brain's motor pathways.

Jaw Neoplasm

An abnormal new growth in the upper or lower jawbone or nearby tissues. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause swelling, pain, loose teeth, numbness, or bone damage. A cyst is a related jaw lesion but is not itself a neoplasm.

Jaw Pain

Pain in the jaw, jaw joint, or chewing muscles caused by temporomandibular disorders, dental disease, infection, injury, or less commonly heart or nerve disease. It may occur with chest discomfort, sweating, breathlessness, exertion, restricted movement, or persistent pain.

Jaw Thrust Maneuver

An airway-opening technique that moves the lower jaw forward without bending the neck. It is used when a neck injury is possible.

Jaw Tumors And Cysts

Abnormal growths or cystic lesions in the jawbones or adjacent tissues. They include odontogenic lesions arising from tooth-forming tissues, bone tumors, giant-cell lesions, and nonodontogenic cysts. Their behavior ranges from benign to malignant, and some cause jaw expansion, pain, tooth displacement, numbness, or bone destruction.

Jaw-Winking Syndrome

A condition present from birth in which a drooping upper eyelid briefly lifts when the jaw moves, such as

during chewing. It results from misdirected nerve signals between muscles that move the jaw and eyelid.

Alternate Names:
Marcus Gunn Jaw-Winking Phenomenon; Trigemino-Oculomotor Synkinesis

Jehovah's Witness

A member of a Christian religious group whose beliefs may lead them to decline transfusions of whole blood and certain blood components. Individual choices about blood products and medical procedures vary.

Jejunal Atresia

A condition present at birth in which part of the jejunum, a section of the small intestine, is closed or missing. It causes bowel blockage in a newborn, with green vomiting, a swollen abdomen, and failure to pass the first stool.

Jejunal Diverticulum

A pouch that forms in the wall of the jejunum, the middle part of the small intestine. It may cause no symptoms, but multiple pouches can be associated with bacterial overgrowth, poor absorption, inflammation, or bleeding.

Jejunal Fistula

An abnormal connection involving the jejunum and another organ, the skin, or a body surface. It may cause intestinal contents to leak, infection, malnutrition, dehydration, or sepsis.

Jejunal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the jejunum, the middle segment of the small intestine, which may cause maroon or black stool, anemia, abdominal pain, or shock depending on its rate and cause.

Jejunal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the jejunum, the middle part of the small intestine. It may be benign or cancerous and can cause pain, bleeding, anemia, vomiting, blockage, or weight loss.

Jejunal Stenosis

Narrowing of the jejunal lumen that can impede intestinal contents and cause cramping, vomiting, distension, malabsorption, or obstruction; causes include Crohn disease, adhesions, tumors, and ischemic injury.

Jejunal Ulcer

An ulcerated break in the lining of the jejunum, caused by inflammation, infection, ischemia, medicines, tumor, or anastomotic disease and potentially producing pain, bleeding, or perforation.

Jejunitis

Inflammation of the lining of the jejunum, the middle section of the small intestine. Causes include infection, Crohn disease, reduced blood flow, and some medicines; symptoms may include abdominal pain, diarrhea, fever, or intestinal bleeding.

Jejunoileal Atresia

A birth defect in which part of the small intestine is completely closed or missing, so milk and digestive fluid cannot pass. Newborns may develop green vomiting, a swollen abdomen, and failure to pass stool. Imaging shows the blockage, and surgery restores intestinal passage.

Jejunojejunostomy

A surgical connection between two parts of the jejunum, the middle section of the small intestine. It may be created during operations such as gastric bypass or to restore the passage of intestinal contents after disease or injury.

Jejunostomy

A surgically created opening into the jejunum, often used for placement of a feeding tube when nutrition cannot safely be given through the stomach.

Jejunostomy Feeding Tube

A tube that delivers liquid nutrition directly into the jejunum, the middle part of the small intestine. It is used when feeding through the mouth or stomach is not possible or suitable.

Jejunum

The middle segment of the small intestine, between the duodenum and ileum. It mixes and propels chyme, secretes fluid and digestive substances, and absorbs much of the nutrients, water, and electrolytes from intestinal contents. Its lining also contributes to gut immune defense. Nutrient absorption continues in other parts of the small intestine.

Jellyfish Sting

A painful skin reaction caused when a jellyfish tentacle releases venom into the skin. It may cause burning, redness, and raised lines; severe exposure can cause vomiting, breathing trouble, fainting, or widespread symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Jellyfish Envenomation

Jellyfish Stings

Alternate name; see *Jellyfish Sting*.

Jendrassik Maneuver

A technique used during a reflex examination in which a person hooks the fingers together and pulls the hands apart, or tenses another muscle group. This can make a tendon reflex, such as the knee reflex, easier to observe.

Alternate Names:
Jendrassik Reinforcement

Jendrassik's Maneuver

Alternate name; see *Jendrassik Maneuver*.

Jerk Nystagmus

Repeated involuntary eye movements with a slow movement in one direction followed by a quick movement back. It may result from problems in the balance organs, cerebellum, or brainstem.

Jerusalem Cherry Poisoning

Jerusalem cherry poisoning follows ingestion of Solanum pseudocapsicum berries, which contain toxic compounds that may cause gastrointestinal symptoms, confusion, weakness, or cardiac effects.

Jervell and Lange-Nielsen Syndrome

A rare, inherited genetic condition characterized by severe hearing loss present from birth combined with an electrical abnormality in the heart known as long QT syndrome. This electrical delay makes the heart vulnerable to dangerously fast, irregular heartbeats, which can cause fainting spells, seizures, or sudden cardiac arrest, often triggered by emotional stress, exercise, or sudden loud noises.

Alternate Names:
JLNS; Cardioauditory Syndrome

Jet Lag

Temporary circadian rhythm disruption after rapid travel across time zones, causing sleep disturbance, fatigue, impaired concentration, and sometimes gastrointestinal symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Desynchronosis; Time Zone Change Syndrome

Jet Lag Prevention

Alternate topic; see *Jet Lag*.

Jeune Syndrome

A rare inherited bone disorder in which the chest is unusually narrow and the limbs are short. It may cause breathing problems, extra fingers or toes, and kidney or liver disease.

Alternate Names:
Asphyxiating Thoracic Dystrophy; ATD

Jimsonweed Poisoning

Jimsonweed poisoning causes anticholinergic toxicity, including dilated pupils, dry mouth, rapid heart rate, urinary retention, agitation, delirium, seizures, or coma.

Job Syndrome

A rare inherited immune disorder, usually caused by a change in the *STAT3* gene, that causes eczema, repeated skin and lung infections, and very high levels of immunoglobulin E (IgE). Dental, bone, and facial differences may also occur.

Jock Itch

A dermatophyte fungal infection of the groin, also called tinea cruris. It usually causes an itchy, scaly rash in the groin folds or upper inner thighs and is favored by warm, moist skin.

Alternate Names:
Tinea Cruris; Ringworm of the Groin

Jod-Basedow Phenomenon

Overactive thyroid function triggered by an excess of iodine, usually in a person with thyroid nodules or other thyroid tissue that works independently of normal control. It may cause weight loss, tremor, sweating, or a fast heartbeat.

Joffroy Sign

A rarely used physical examination sign associated with Graves orbitopathy: the forehead does not wrinkle normally when a person looks upward with the head held still. The sign alone does not establish a diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Joffroy's Sign; Thyrotoxic Forehead Sign

Johanson-Blizzard Syndrome

A rare autosomal recessive congenital malformation syndrome caused by mutations in the UBR1 gene, characterized by exocrine pancreatic insufficiency, hypoplasia or aplasia of the nasal alae ('beaked nose'), scalp vertex defects, oligodontia, sensorineural hearing loss, and growth retardation.

Alternate Names:
JBS; Pancreatic Insufficiency-Alar Hypoplasia Syndrome

Joint

The place where two or more bones meet. Joints may be fixed, slightly movable, or freely movable, such as the knee, hip, or shoulder.

Joint Aspiration

A needle procedure that removes fluid from a joint for testing or symptom relief, helping assess infection, bleeding, crystals, or inflammation.

Joint Capsule

A tough envelope surrounding a freely movable joint. Its inner synovial membrane produces fluid that helps the joint move, while the capsule helps hold the bones together and provides stability.

Joint Contracture

Permanent or long-lasting limitation of joint movement caused by tightening or scarring of muscles, tendons, ligaments, the joint capsule, skin, or nearby tissues. It may follow immobility, injury, burns, inflammation, or nerve disease.

Joint Crepitus

A grating, crackling, or popping sound or sensation during joint movement. Painless joint noises can occur without disease; grating with pain or swelling may occur with osteoarthritis, cartilage damage, or a tendon moving over bone.

Joint Diseases

Conditions that affect joints, including osteoarthritis, inflammatory arthritis, gout, infection, and injury. They may cause pain, swelling, stiffness, deformity, or reduced movement.

Joint Effusion

Extra fluid inside a joint, often causing swelling, stiffness, or restricted movement. Causes include injury, infection, inflammatory arthritis, bleeding, and crystal disease. Testing the fluid can help identify the cause.

Joint Fluid Culture

Joint fluid culture tests synovial fluid for bacterial, fungal, or other organisms when septic arthritis is suspected; results are interpreted with cell count, crystals, and clinical findings.

Joint Fluid Gram Stain

A quick laboratory test that stains fluid removed from a swollen joint to look for bacteria. It can support the evaluation of a serious joint infection but a negative result does not rule infection out.

Joint Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Arthritis*.

Joint Injection

A procedure in which medicine or another fluid is injected into a joint. It may be used to ease inflammation or pain, or to help diagnose the cause of joint symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Intra-Articular Injection

Joint Mouse

A loose piece of cartilage, bone, or other tissue inside a joint that can cause catching, locking, pain, or swelling.

Joint Pain

Pain felt within or around one or more joints. Causes include arthritis, injury, overuse, infection, or gout; nearby tendon or bursa problems can also cause pain around a joint without damage inside it. Swelling, warmth, redness, stiffness, or reduced movement may occur.

Joint Prosthesis

An artificial joint or implant designed to replace a damaged or diseased biological joint, restoring mobility and relieving chronic pain.

Joint Reconstruction

Surgery to restore the structure and function of a damaged or unstable joint by repairing or replacing injured ligaments, tendons, cartilage, bone, or other supporting tissues. It may be performed arthroscopically or through an open incision after trauma, sports injury, degeneration, or congenital abnormality.

Joint Replacement

Surgery that removes damaged joint surfaces and replaces them with artificial parts to reduce pain and improve movement. It is commonly performed for severe arthritis or joint destruction.

Joint Replacement Rehabilitation

Exercise, education, and daily-activity training after joint replacement, helping restore safe movement, strength, balance, confidence, and independence.

Joint Stiffness

Reduced ease or range of joint movement, often worse after rest. Causes include arthritis, injury, inflammation, prolonged immobility, or muscle and tendon disorders. It may occur with swelling, redness, fever, severe pain, or inability to use the joint.

Joint Swelling

Enlargement of a joint caused by excess synovial fluid, blood, inflammation, infection, trauma, or structural disease. It may be accompanied by pain, warmth, stiffness, or restricted movement and can indicate inflammatory or septic arthritis.

Joint X-Ray

An X-ray picture of a joint used to look for broken bones, abnormal alignment, arthritis-related wear, bone loss, deposits, or other changes. It uses a small amount of radiation and does not show all soft-tissue injuries.

Jones Criteria

A widely used medical guideline created to help doctors diagnose acute rheumatic fever, an inflammatory illness that can develop after an untreated strep throat infection. The criteria combine evidence of a recent strep infection with major clinical signs—including heart valve inflammation (carditis), painful swollen joints (arthritis), involuntary jerky movements (chorea), distinct skin rashes, and small nodules under the skin—along with minor signs like fever and elevated blood inflammation markers.

Alternate Names:
Revised Jones Criteria; AHA Rheumatic Fever Criteria

Jones Fracture

A fracture in zone 2 at the metaphyseal-diaphyseal junction of the fifth metatarsal, with the fracture line extending into the fourth-fifth intermetatarsal joint. It is distinct from a tuberosity avulsion frac-

ture and a more distal shaft stress fracture. The region has a relatively limited blood supply, increasing the risk of delayed union or nonunion. Use of the term varies, so the fracture location is important.

Alternate Names:
Fifth Metatarsal Watershed Fracture; Metaphyseal-Diaphyseal Fifth Metatarsal Fracture

Jones Metatarsal Fracture

Alternate name; see *Jones Fracture*.

Jones Tube

A small tube that creates a drain from the inner corner of the eye to the nose when the usual tear-drainage channels are severely blocked. It is used in a procedure called conjunctivodacryocystorhinostomy.

Jonston's Alopecia

Historical or misspelled index form for alopecia, meaning hair loss; see *Alopecia*.

Joubert Syndrome

A usually autosomal-recessive neurodevelopmental disorder defined by a characteristic cerebellar and brainstem malformation, the molar tooth sign on brain MRI. Features may include infantile hypotonia, abnormal eye movements, disordered breathing, ataxia, and developmental differences. Kidney, liver, retinal, or skeletal involvement may also occur.

Alternate Names:
JSRD; Joubert-Related Disorder

Joule-Thomson Effect

The temperature change that occurs when a real gas expands from high to low pressure without exchanging heat with its surroundings. In cryoablation, expanding pressurized argon cools a probe enough to freeze and destroy targeted tissue.

Alternate Names:
Joule-Kelvin Effect

JRA

Abbreviation for juvenile idiopathic arthritis, a group of inflammatory joint diseases beginning in childhood; see *Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis*.

J Receptor

A term for pulmonary vagal C-fiber sensory endings located near alveolar capillaries, also called juxtacapillary receptors. Experimental stimulation can produce rapid, shallow breathing and other reflex responses, including during pulmonary congestion. Their contribution to breathlessness in people remains uncertain.

Alternate Names:
Juxtacapillary Receptor

Jugular

Relating to the neck, especially the jugular veins that carry blood from the head and neck back to the heart.

Jugular Bulb

A widened area at the upper end of the internal jugular vein, just below the skull. It lies close to the middle ear and can vary in size and position.

Jugular Foramen

An opening at the base of the skull through which a major neck vein and several nerves pass. Disease in this area can cause difficulty swallowing, hoarseness, shoulder weakness, hearing symptoms, or other neurologic problems.

Jugular Foramen Syndrome

A group of problems caused by damage to nerves passing through an opening at the base of the skull. It can cause difficulty swallowing, hoarseness, and weakness when turning the head or lifting the shoulder.

Alternate Names:
Vernet Syndrome; Posterior Lacerated Foramen Syndrome

Jugular Vein

A major vein that carries blood from the head, face, and neck back to the heart. Each side has an internal jugular vein and an external jugular vein.

Jugular Veins

Alternate name; see *Jugular Vein*.

Jugular Venous Distention

Visible fullness or raised pulsation of the neck veins, usually reflecting increased pressure in the veins returning blood to the heart. It can occur in conditions that raise pressure on the right side of the heart.

Alternate Names:
Jugular Venous Distension; JVD

Jugular Venous Pressure

A physical examination assessment of the pressure inside the right side of the heart, evaluated by observing the height of the pulse in the jugular veins of the neck. Because the jugular vein connects directly to the right upper chamber of the heart without valves, changes in fluid pressure cause the blood column in the neck to rise or fall. An unusually high jugular venous pulse is a classic sign of fluid overload or heart failure.

Alternate Names:
JVP; Jugular Venous Pulse

Jugular Venous Waveform

The pattern of rises and falls seen in the neck vein during a heartbeat. It reflects pressure changes as the right side of the heart contracts and fills.

Alternate Names:
JVP Waveform

Jugulodigastric Node

A lymph node in the upper neck near the angle of the jaw. It receives drainage from the tonsils and nearby parts of the throat and may enlarge during throat infections.

Alternate Names:
Tonsillar Lymph Node; Subdigastric Node

Jumper's Knee

Alternate name for patellar tendinopathy, an overuse disorder of the tendon connecting the kneecap to the shinbone; see *Patellar Tendinopathy*.

Jumping Frenchmen of Maine

A rare historical startle disorder characterized by an exaggerated response to sudden stimuli, sometimes with involuntary jumping or other abrupt movements.

Junctional Bradycardia

A slow heart rhythm that starts near the connection between the heart's upper and lower chambers. The heartbeat is often below 40 beats per minute, and the usual electrical signs from the upper chambers may be absent or reversed.

Junctional Ectopic Tachycardia

An unusually fast heart rhythm that starts near the connection between the upper and lower chambers. It occurs most often in children after heart surgery and can make the heart pump less effectively.

Alternate Names:
JET

Junctional Epidermolysis Bullosa

A severe inherited blistering disorder in which the layers of skin separate easily. It can cause widespread blisters, skin wounds, poor feeding, and other complications from birth.

Alternate Names:
JEB

Junctional Escape Rhythm

A backup heart rhythm that starts near the connection between the upper and lower chambers when the heart's usual pacemaker is too slow or its signals are blocked. It is generally slower than a normal resting heartbeat.

Alternate Names:
AV Junctional Rhythm; Nodal Escape Rhythm

Junctional Nevus

A usually benign, often flat mole formed by pigment cells at the junction between the outer and deeper layers of skin. It may change in size, shape, color, or symptoms.

Junctional Premature Complex

An early extra heartbeat that starts near the connection between the heart's upper and lower chambers. It may occur before the next expected beat and can be followed by a brief pause.

Alternate Names:
PJC; Premature Junctional Contraction

Junctional Rhythm

A heart rhythm that starts near the connection between the upper and lower chambers instead of the heart's usual pacemaker. It may be slow or regular and can occur when the usual pacemaker is suppressed or blocked.

Junctional Tachycardia

A fast heart rhythm that starts near the connection between the upper and lower chambers. It may occur with heart disease, certain medicines, or after heart surgery; the electrical pattern helps distinguish it from other fast rhythms.

Jungian Analysis

Jungian analysis is a psychotherapy approach based on Carl Jung's theories, using exploration of unconscious processes, symbols, dreams, and personality development.

Juvenile Absence Epilepsy

A generalized epilepsy syndrome that typically begins in adolescence and causes brief absence seizures, usually less often than in childhood absence epilepsy. An electroencephalogram shows generalized spike-and-wave activity; generalized tonic-clonic seizures may also occur.

Alternate Names:
JAE; Adolescent Absence Epilepsy

Juvenile Angiofibroma

Alternate name; see *Juvenile Nasopharyngeal Angiofibroma*.

Juvenile Arthritis

Alternate name; see *Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis*.

Juvenile Astrocytoma

An astrocytoma, a tumor arising from star-shaped support cells called astrocytes, in a child's or adolescent's brain or spinal cord. These tumors include slow-growing low-grade types, such as pilocytic astrocytoma, and faster-growing high-grade types. Symptoms depend on the site and may include headache, seizures, vision changes, weakness, balance problems, or hormone disturbances; modern classification identifies specific subtypes by tissue and molecular features.

Juvenile Dermatomyositis

An autoimmune illness in children that weakens muscles, especially around the hips and shoulders, and causes a purple rash around the eyes or raised patches over the knuckles. It may also affect swallowing, breathing, or other organs.

Juvenile Diabetes

An outdated, imprecise name historically used for type 1 diabetes. Type 1 diabetes can begin at any age, and diabetes diagnosed in childhood may also be type 2 or monogenic diabetes. The specific diabetes type is determined by its underlying cause; see *Type 1 Diabetes*.

Juvenile Granulosa Cell Tumor

A rare ovarian tumor arising from hormone-producing granulosa cells, usually in children or young adults. It may produce estrogen, causing early puberty in children or irregular bleeding in adults. Some tumors are cancerous.

Juvenile Hypermobile Spectrum Disorder

A nonstandard descriptive label for symptomatic joint hypermobility in a child or adolescent. Current pediatric classification distinguishes pediatric generalized joint hypermobility from pediatric generalized hypermobility spectrum disorder according to musculoskeletal complications, skin and tissue features, and associated comorbidities. Adult hEDS criteria are used after biological maturity.

Juvenile Hypermobility Syndrome

An older term for joint hypermobility with symp-

toms in a child or adolescent, such as pain, instability, or repeated sprains. The current pediatric framework uses pediatric generalized joint hypermobility (pGJH) and pediatric generalized hypermobility spectrum disorder (pgHSD); classification considers joint mobility, musculoskeletal complications, skin and tissue features, and related health conditions. The classification may change as a child grows and develops.

Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis

A group of autoimmune inflammatory conditions that cause persistent joint swelling, pain, warmth, and stiffness in children under the age of 16, lasting for at least six weeks. While the exact cause is unknown, the immune system mistakenly attacks healthy joint tissues. Depending on the subtype, it can affect one joint, multiple joints, or the entire body (systemic arthritis, causing fevers and rashes), and may also cause inflammation inside the eyes.

Alternate Names:
JIA; Juvenile Rheumatoid Arthritis (JRA)

Juvenile Laryngeal Papillomatosis

A condition in which wart-like growths repeatedly form in the voice box, usually because of human papillomavirus types 6 or 11. The growths can cause hoarseness and noisy or difficult breathing.

Alternate Names:
Juvenile-Onset Recurrent Respiratory Papillomatosis; JORRP

Juvenile Myoclonic Epilepsy

A generalized epilepsy syndrome that typically begins in adolescence and causes myoclonic jerks, often after awakening, with possible generalized tonic-clonic or absence seizures.

Juvenile Nasopharyngeal Angiofibroma

A noncancerous but highly blood-rich tumor that usually develops behind the nose in adolescent boys. It can cause repeated nosebleeds, nasal blockage, or facial swelling.

Alternate Names:
JNA; Nasopharyngeal Fibroangioma

Juvenile Osteoporosis

Low bone strength during childhood or adolescence that increases the risk of fractures. It may occur on its own or result from chronic illness, poor nutrition, hormone disorders, limited mobility, or medicines.

Juvenile Polyposis Syndrome

An inherited disorder in which multiple hamartomatous polyps, called juvenile polyps, develop in the gastrointestinal tract, especially the colon and stomach. Polyps may cause bleeding or anemia, and the syndrome increases the risk of colorectal and gastric cancer.

Juvenile Retinoschisis

An inherited retinal disorder, usually X-linked, in which layers of the retina split and impair central or peripheral vision; see *Retinoschisis*.

Juvenile Rheumatoid Arthritis

Older name for juvenile idiopathic arthritis, a group of inflammatory joint diseases beginning before age 16; see *Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis*.

Juvenile Schizophrenia

Alternate name; see *Childhood Schizophrenia*.

Juvenile Xanthogranuloma

A rare, usually harmless growth of immune cells in the skin of an infant or young child, appearing as a firm red, yellow, or brown bump. It often fades without treatment, but rarely affects the eye or internal organs.

Juxta-Articular

Located next to a joint. The term may describe bone, soft tissue, swelling, a cyst, or a deposit beside a joint rather than within the joint itself.

Juxtaglomerular Apparatus

A microscopic sensory structure located inside each kidney nephron, positioned right where blood vessels enter the filtering unit. It continuously monitors blood pressure in the kidney and the salt concentration in the filtered fluid. When it detects low

blood pressure, reduced blood flow, or low sodium levels, its specialized cells release the enzyme renin, triggering hormonal pathways that constrict blood vessels and help restore normal blood pressure and fluid balance.

Juxtaglomerular Cells

Specialized cells in the kidney that release renin when blood flow or salt delivery to the kidney is low. Renin helps regulate blood pressure and the body's salt and fluid balance.

Alternate Names:
JG Cells; Granular Cells

Juxtaglomerular Cell Tumor

A rare kidney tumor that releases renin, a hormone that helps control blood pressure. It can cause high blood pressure and low blood potassium.

Alternate Names:
Reninoma; Juxtaglomerular Renin-Secreting Tumor

Juxtavesical

Next to the urinary bladder. The term often describes the lower part of a ureter as it approaches the bladder.

J Wave

A notch or slur at the end of the QRS complex, or a positive deflection near the junction of the QRS complex and ST segment on an electrocardiogram. An Osborn wave is a prominent J wave classically associated with hypothermia. Similar terminal QRS changes may occur in early-repolarization patterns and other conditions.

K

Kabuki Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder that may cause distinctive facial features, short stature, developmental or learning difficulties, weak muscle tone, skeletal changes, and heart defects. Hearing loss, seizures, immune problems, and kidney abnormalities may also occur. Most cases result from a change in the *KMT2D* or *KDM6A* gene.

Alternate Names:
Niikawa-Kuroki Syndrome

Kahler Disease

Older name; see *Multiple Myeloma*.

Kahler's Disease

Alternate name; see *Multiple Myeloma*.

Kala-Azar

A serious parasitic infection caused by Leishmania species and transmitted by sandflies. It may cause prolonged fever, weight loss, enlargement of the spleen and liver, and suppression of blood-cell production.

Alternate Names:
Black Sickness; Dumdum Fever

Kallikrein-Kinin System

A group of blood and tissue proteins that produces kinins, including bradykinin. These messengers widen blood vessels, increase leakage from small vessels, and contribute to pain and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Kininergic System; Bradykinin Cascade; Kinin-Kallikrein System; Kallikrein-Kinin Cascade

Kallmann Syndrome

A congenital form of hypogonadotropic hypogonadism in which deficient gonadotropin-releasing hormone signaling delays or prevents puberty. It is associated with a reduced or absent sense of smell because development of smell-related neurons is also affected.

Kallmann Syndrome and IHH

Alternate topic; see *Hypogonadotropic Hypogonadism* and *Kallmann Syndrome*.

Kanamycin

An antibiotic used for some serious bacterial infections. It can permanently damage hearing and harm the kidneys, especially with prolonged or high-dose use.

Kangaroo Care

A care method for preterm or low-birth-weight newborns. It combines prolonged skin-to-skin contact, begun as soon as possible after birth, with exclusive breast-milk feeding. This practice supports thermal regulation and physiologic stability and may continue after hospital discharge.

Alternate Names:
Kangaroo Mother Care; KMC

Kaolin

A soft clay mineral used in some medicines, laboratory products, and industrial materials. Breathing large amounts of kaolin dust over time can damage the lungs.

Kaposiform Hemangioendothelioma

A rare blood-vessel tumor that usually affects infants and young children. It can grow into nearby tissue and may cause a serious loss of platelets and problems with blood clotting.

Alternate Names:
KHE

Kaposi Sarcoma

A malignant vascular tumor caused by Kaposi sarcoma-associated herpesvirus (HHV-8) that may affect the skin, mucous membranes, lymph nodes, or internal organs. Lesions are often red, purple, or brown patches, plaques, or nodules; clinical forms include classic, endemic, transplant-associated, and HIV-associated disease.

Alternate Names:
Kaposi's Sarcoma

Karnofsky Performance Status

A 0-to-100 scale describing a person's ability to carry out daily activities and care for themselves. It is used to record functional status, especially in cancer care.

Kartagener Syndrome

An inherited condition in which tiny hair-like structures that clear mucus do not work properly. It causes repeated sinus and lung infections and may place the internal organs in a reversed position.

Kartagener Triad

The combination of reversed internal-organ positions, long-term sinus inflammation, and widened damaged airways. It results from an inherited problem with microscopic moving hairs that clear mucus.

Karyolysis

Fading and dissolution of a cell nucleus as its DNA is degraded, seen in dying cells, especially in necrosis.

Karyomegaly

Abnormal enlargement of a cell's nucleus, which contains most of its genetic material. It can occur during cell injury or repair and in some tumors; by itself, it does not establish that a growth is cancerous.

Karyorrhexis

Fragmentation of a cell nucleus into pieces of condensed chromatin during cell death. It occurs in necrosis and apoptosis.

Karyotype

A person's complete set of chromosomes; the term also refers to a laboratory image or report showing chromosomes arranged by number and structure. It can reveal some chromosome-number or large structural changes but does not detect every genetic condition.

Karyotyping

A laboratory test that examines chromosomes in dividing cells to detect some missing, extra, or rearranged chromosomes. It may be used in pregnancy, infertility, repeated miscarriage, developmental conditions, or blood cancers.

Kasabach-Merritt Phenomenon

A severe consumptive coagulopathy associated with kaposiform hemangioendothelioma or tufted angioma, usually in infants and young children. Platelets are trapped within the tumor, causing profound thrombocytopenia and often low fibrinogen and other clotting abnormalities; microangiopathic hemolytic anemia may also occur.

Alternate Names:
KMP; Kasabach-Merritt Syndrome; KMS

Kasai Procedure

An operation for babies with biliary atresia, in which the blocked bile ducts outside the liver are removed and a loop of intestine is connected to the liver so bile can drain. Earlier surgery gives the best chance of restoring bile flow, but many children eventually need a liver transplant.

Alternate Names:
Hepatoportoenterostomy; Kasai Operation; Portoenterostomy

Kashin-Beck Disease

A long-term bone and joint disease seen in some parts of Asia. It can cause pain, stiffness, joint deformity, and poor growth; its cause is not fully understood but may involve low selenium and other environmental factors.

Katayama Fever

An acute systemic reaction to schistosome infection, usually occurring weeks after exposure and causing fever, rash, cough, abdominal symptoms, and eosinophilia.

Alternate Names:
Katayama Syndrome; Acute Bilharziasis

Katz Index

A scale that assesses independence in six basic activities of daily living: bathing, dressing, toileting, transferring, continence, and feeding.

Kava

A plant-derived product traditionally used in the Pacific and marketed for anxiety or relaxation. It can cause drowsiness, interact with medicines, and rarely cause serious liver injury.

Kawasaki Disease

An acute inflammatory illness that causes swelling in the walls of medium-sized blood vessels throughout the body, most commonly affecting children under five years of age. Its most serious concern is inflammation of the coronary arteries that supply blood to the heart muscle, which can lead to coronary artery aneurysms if untreated. Symptoms include a high, persistent fever lasting five or more days, widespread skin rash, bloodshot eyes without discharge, swollen lymph nodes in the neck, cracked red lips, and a bright red 'strawberry' tongue.

Alternate Names:
Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome; KD

Kawasaki Disease Diagnostic Criteria

Classic Kawasaki disease is identified by fever for at least five days and at least four of five principal findings: bilateral nonpurulent conjunctivitis, oral or lip changes, a polymorphous rash, extremity changes, and cervical lymphadenopathy with at least one node 1.5 cm or larger, usually unilateral. With four or more findings, diagnosis may be made after four days of fever; incomplete forms also occur.

Kayser-Fleischer Rings

A distinctive dark ring of golden-brown or greenish pigment that encircles the outer edge of the cornea (the clear front window of the eye). It is caused by excess copper accumulating in the eye tissues and is a hallmark physical sign of Wilson disease, a rare genetic disorder where the body cannot properly eliminate copper.

KC

Common abbreviation for keratoconus, a progressive thinning and cone-shaped bulging of the cornea; see *Keratoconus*.

K-Complex

A large brain-wave pattern seen during stage 2 sleep. It may occur on its own or after a sound or other sensory stimulus and is recorded during an electroencephalogram (EEG).

Kearns-Sayre Syndrome

A mitochondrial DNA deletion syndrome, usually sporadic rather than inherited. It is classically defined by onset before age 20, progressive external ophthalmoplegia, pigmentary retinopathy, and at least one of cardiac conduction disease, cerebellar ataxia, or elevated cerebrospinal-fluid protein. Short stature, muscle weakness, hearing loss, and endocrine abnormalities may also occur.

Keel Breast

Alternate name; see *Pectus Carinatum*.

Kegel

Alternate name; see *Kegel Exercise*.

Kegel Exercise

Repeated tightening and relaxing of pelvic-floor muscles to improve strength and control, helping reduce urine leakage and support pelvic organs.

Kegel Exercises

Alternate plural form; see *Kegel Exercise*.

Kehr Sign

Pain felt at the tip of the left shoulder when blood or irritation affects the underside of the diaphragm, the main breathing muscle. It can occur with irritation from a spleen injury but is not specific to it.

Keloid

A firm, raised overgrowth of scar tissue that may continue growing beyond the original wound. Unlike a hypertrophic scar, it does not remain confined to the wound margins and usually persists; it may itch or feel tender and can follow surgery, injury, burns, acne, or piercings.

Alternate Names:
Keloid Scar; Cheloid

Keloid and Hypertrophic Scar

A general term for raised scars caused by excess scar tissue. A hypertrophic scar stays within the original wound, while a keloid grows beyond it. Either may itch, hurt, or feel tight.

Keloid Scar

Alternate name; see *Keloid*.

Keratan Sulfate

A complex sugar found mainly in the clear front of the eye, cartilage, and brain. In some inherited disorders it cannot be broken down properly and builds up, damaging the eyes, bones, or other tissues.

Keratan Sulphate

Alternate spelling; see *Keratan Sulfate*.

Keratectomy

Removal or reshaping of part of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It may be done to correct vision or remove abnormal tissue, and it can affect eyesight.

Keratic Precipitates

Small groups of inflammatory cells that collect on the inner surface of the cornea, usually during inflammation inside the front of the eye. Their size and appearance can help describe the type of inflammation.

Keratin

A strong structural protein forming much of the skin's outer layer, hair, nails, and other protective tissues. It helps resist water loss, friction, chemicals, and physical injury.

Keratinocyte

The main type of cell in the outer layer of skin. It produces keratin and helps form the skin barrier that limits water loss and protects against injury and infection.

Keratinocytes

Plural form; see *Keratinocyte*.

Keratin Pearl

A round, layered collection of keratin seen under a microscope in some well-differentiated squamous cell skin cancers.

Alternate Names:
Squamous Pearl; Horn Pearl

Keratitis

Inflammation of the cornea, the clear front layer of the eye. Infection, injury, contact-lens wear, or other conditions may cause pain, redness, tearing, light sensitivity, blurred vision, or clouding. Severe keratitis may cause a corneal ulcer.

Keratoacanthoma

A fast-growing, dome-shaped skin tumor with a central plug of keratin, usually on sun-exposed skin. It can resemble squamous cell skin cancer and may be difficult to distinguish from it in a small sample.

Alternate Names:
Crateriform Epithelioma

Keratocele

Severe thinning or ulceration of the cornea that allows its inner layers to bulge outward. It can lead

to a hole in the cornea and permanent loss of vision.

Keratoconjunctivitis

Inflammation of the cornea and conjunctiva, the clear tissues at the front of the eye. It can cause redness, pain, discharge, light sensitivity, or blurred vision.

Keratoconjunctivitis Sicca

Long-lasting dryness and inflammation of the eye's front surface, commonly called dry-eye disease. It can cause burning, grittiness, redness, fluctuating vision, or light sensitivity because too few tears are made or tears evaporate too quickly.

Alternate Names:
Dry Eye Disease; Dry Eye Syndrome

Keratoconus

A condition in which the cornea, the clear front of the eye, thins and bulges into a cone shape. It can cause blurred or distorted vision, glare, and light sensitivity, usually in both eyes but often unevenly.

Keratocyte Count

An estimate of the number of living support cells in the middle layer of the cornea. It may be used to assess corneal health or changes after eye surgery.

Keratoderma

Excessive thickening of the skin on the palms or soles. It may be inherited or develop because of skin disease, infection, medicines, or another illness and can cause painful cracks or difficulty walking.

Keratoderma Blennorrhagica

Alternate spelling; see *Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum*.

Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum

Thickened, scaly, or pus-filled skin lesions on the palms and soles associated with reactive arthritis. The lesions may spread to other areas and often appear after an infection affecting the urinary or digestive tract.

Keratoderma Blenorrhagicum

Alternate spelling; see *Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum*.

Keratodermia Blennorrhagicum

Alternate spelling; see *Keratoderma Blennorrhagicum*.

Keratolysis

Breakdown or loss of the outer, keratin-rich layer of skin. It can occur in some skin infections and inflammatory conditions.

Keratolytics

Substances, such as salicylic acid or urea, that soften and loosen excess thickened skin. They are used in some products for corns, calluses, and certain skin conditions.

Keratoma

A localized thickening or growth of the outer skin, such as a callus or corn.

Keratomalacia

Softening and ulceration of the cornea caused most often by severe vitamin A deficiency, potentially leading to blindness.

Keratometer

An eye instrument that measures the curvature of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. The measurement helps assess astigmatism and fit rigid contact lenses.

Keratometry

Measurement of the curve of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It helps assess focusing problems and choose contact lenses or an artificial lens for cataract surgery.

Keratoplasty

Surgery to replace or reshape part or all of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It can restore vision after corneal damage, but healing problems, infection, and rejection of donor tissue

are possible.

Keratoprosthesis

An artificial cornea implanted to restore sight when a donor-corneal transplant is unlikely to work, such as after severe chemical injury or extensive surface damage. It carries risks of infection, glaucoma, and device problems.

Keratosis

A thickened, rough, or otherwise abnormal area of skin caused by excess keratin. Some forms are harmless, while others result from infection, inflammation, sun damage, or a change that can precede skin cancer.

Keratosis Follicularis

Alternate name for Darier disease; see *Darier's Disease*.

Keratosis Follicularis (Darier Disease)

Alternate name; see *Darier's Disease*.

Keratosis Obturans

A buildup of shed skin cells that blocks the ear canal. It can cause ear pain, hearing loss, discharge, and widening or damage of the canal.

Keratosis Pilaris

A common, harmless skin condition that causes small, rough bumps around hair follicles, usually on the upper arms, thighs, buttocks, or face.

Alternate Names:
KP; Chicken Skin; Follicular Keratosis; Follicular Hyperkeratosis

Keratosis Seborrheic

Alternate word order; see *Seborrheic Keratosis*.

Kerion

An inflamed, boggy, pus-forming mass caused by a fungal infection of hair-bearing skin, usually a severe form of tinea capitis.

Kerley A Lines

Long, fine lines seen on a chest X-ray, usually spreading outward from the central lung areas. They can reflect fluid buildup in the lung tissue.

Alternate Names:
Kerley's A Lines; Upper Zone Interstitial Edema Lines

Kerley B Lines

Short, thin lines seen near the outer edges and bases of the lungs on a chest X-ray. They commonly reflect fluid buildup in the lung tissue, often related to heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Kerley's B Lines; Septal Lines

Kernicterus

Permanent brain damage caused by very high levels of bilirubin, a yellow substance that builds up during severe newborn jaundice. It can cause movement problems, hearing loss, problems looking upward, and damage to tooth enamel.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Bilirubin Encephalopathy; Nuclear Jaundice; Chronic Bilirubin Toxicity

Kernig Sign

Pain or resistance when the knee is straightened while the hip is bent. It may suggest irritation of the coverings of the brain and spinal cord, such as with meningitis, but it is not diagnostic by itself.

Kernig's Sign

Alternate spelling; see *Kernig Sign*.

Kernohan Notch Phenomenon

Weakness on the same side of the body as a brain injury, caused when pressure from brain herniation pushes the brainstem against the opposite side of the skull opening. This misleading sign can make the injury appear to be on the wrong side.

Alternate Names:
Kernohan-Woltman Notch Phenomenon; Kernohan Sign

Kerosene Poisoning

Harm after swallowing or inhaling kerosene. The greatest danger is entry into the lungs, which can cause chemical pneumonia; coughing, choking, breathing difficulty, drowsiness, or vomiting may occur.

Keshan Disease

A heart-muscle disease linked to severe selenium deficiency, occurring mainly in regions where soil and food contain little selenium. It can weaken the heart and cause heart failure.

Ketamine

A dissociative anesthetic used for anesthesia and procedural sedation. It acts mainly by blocking NMDA-type glutamate receptors and is also used in selected settings for severe pain or depression. It can cause altered perception, increased blood pressure, and drowsiness.

Ketamine Hydrochloride

Alternate name; see *Ketamine*.

Ketamine Toxicity

Harm from taking too much ketamine or using it repeatedly. Acute effects may include confusion, hallucinations, poor coordination, rapid heartbeat, or high blood pressure; long-term heavy use can injure the bladder.

Keto Acid

An organic acid that contains a ketone group. Alpha-keto acids form when amino acids lose an amino group and can be used in energy production or to make other substances.

Ketoacidosis

A metabolic acidosis caused by excess ketone bodies in the blood. It can result from severe insulin deficiency, heavy alcohol use, or prolonged starvation. Symptoms may include vomiting, abdominal pain, deep breathing, confusion, or coma; ketosis alone does not necessarily cause acidosis.

Ketoconazole

An antifungal medicine used mainly on the skin or scalp to treat fungal infections. Oral ketoconazole is rarely used because it can cause severe liver injury and interact with many medicines.

Ketogenesis

The production of ketone bodies from fatty acids, mainly in the liver during fasting, prolonged exercise, or inadequate insulin activity.

Ketogenic Diet

A high-fat, very-low-carbohydrate diet with adequate protein that shifts metabolism toward producing and using ketone bodies. Therapeutic forms are used in selected cases of drug-resistant epilepsy, and their macronutrient ratios vary. Potential adverse effects include gastrointestinal symptoms, kidney stones, and changes in blood lipid levels.

Ketone

A type of chemical compound. In medicine, the term often refers to ketone bodies made when the body uses fat for energy; small amounts can be normal, but high levels may cause ketoacidosis.

Ketone Bodies

Water-soluble molecules produced mainly by the liver from fatty-acid-derived acetyl-CoA during fasting, starvation, prolonged exercise, or insulin deficiency. The principal ketone bodies are acetoacetate, beta-hydroxybutyrate, and acetone.

Ketones

Alternate name; see *Ketone Bodies*.

Ketones Blood Test

A blood test measuring ketone bodies, such as beta-hydroxybutyrate, used to assess ketosis and help diagnose or monitor diabetic ketoacidosis and other causes of ketone production.

Ketones Urine Test

A urine test detecting ketone bodies produced when the body metabolizes fat; it can support evaluation

of diabetic ketoacidosis, starvation, vomiting, or other metabolic states but may lag behind blood ketone levels.

Ketonuria

Ketonuria is the presence of ketone bodies in urine, occurring with fasting, vomiting, low-carbohydrate intake, pregnancy, or uncontrolled diabetes; marked ketonuria with hyperglycaemia may indicate diabetic ketoacidosis.

Ketoprofen

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used to reduce pain, inflammation, and fever. It can irritate the stomach and may cause bleeding or kidney problems.

Ketoprofen Overdose

Harm caused by taking too much ketoprofen, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug. It may cause nausea, vomiting, stomach bleeding, drowsiness, kidney injury, seizures, or a dangerous buildup of acid in the blood.

Ketorolac

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for short-term treatment of moderate or severe pain. It can cause stomach bleeding or kidney injury, especially with prolonged use.

Ketorolac Tromethamine

Alternate name; see *Ketorolac*.

Ketosis

A state in which the body makes and uses increased amounts of ketones after breaking down fat for energy. It can occur during fasting or a low-carbohydrate diet, but high ketone levels with illness or high blood sugar may signal diabetic ketoacidosis.

Ketosis-Prone Type 2 Diabetes

A form of diabetes that may present with diabetic ketoacidosis despite features of type 2 diabetes, such as obesity or preserved insulin production. Insulin dependence can change over time according to beta-cell reserve, autoimmunity, and recovery from the initial metabolic stress.

Ketotic Hypoglycemia

Low blood sugar accompanied by ketones, usually after a young child has gone without food or has been ill and unable to eat. Drowsiness, weakness, vomiting, or seizures may occur. Repeated or unusually severe episodes can be caused by cortisol or growth-hormone deficiency, glycogen-storage disease, or another metabolic disorder.

Ketotifen

An allergy medicine that blocks histamine and can reduce allergic symptoms. Eye drops are used for allergic conjunctivitis; tablets are used in some countries for other allergic conditions. It may cause drowsiness.

Kidney

One of two bean-shaped organs that filter waste from the blood into urine. The kidneys also help control body water, salts, blood pressure, and the balance of acids in the blood.

Kidney Abscess

A localized pocket of pus within the kidney, usually caused by a bacterial infection. A perinephric abscess is a related collection outside the kidney.

Alternate Names:
Renal Abscess

Kidney Biopsy

A procedure in which a small sample of kidney tissue is removed, usually with a needle guided by ultrasound, to identify kidney disease. Bleeding is the main risk.

Kidney Calculi

Alternate name; see *Kidney Stone*.

Kidney Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the kidney. Renal cell carcinoma is the most common type in adults, but

other types occur, especially in children.

Kidney Cancer In Children

Cancer arising in a child's kidney. Wilms tumor is the most common type, but other kidney tumors can occur; symptoms may include an abdominal mass, pain, blood in the urine, fever, or high blood pressure.

Kidney Cysts

Fluid-filled sacs in or on the kidneys. Simple cysts are common and usually harmless. Multiple or complex cysts may be linked to inherited kidney disease or reduced kidney function.

Alternate Names:
Renal Cysts

Kidney Disease

Any condition that damages the kidneys or reduces their ability to filter blood, balance fluids and minerals, control blood pressure, or make hormones. Causes include diabetes, high blood pressure, infection, inflammation, inherited disorders, and medicines.

Kidney Disease and Pregnancy

Kidney disease can worsen during pregnancy, and pregnancy can increase the risk of high blood pressure, preeclampsia, preterm birth, or poor fetal growth. Risks are greater with reduced kidney function, high blood pressure, or protein in the urine before pregnancy.

Kidney Disease-Related Anemia

Anemia caused or worsened by kidney disease, mainly because damaged kidneys produce less erythropoietin, the hormone that stimulates red-cell production. Iron deficiency, inflammation, and blood loss may also contribute.

Kidney Diseases

Alternate plural form; see *Kidney Disease*.

Kidney Failure

Severe loss of kidney function. In chronic kidney disease, kidney failure generally means a glomerular filtration rate below 15 mL/min/1.73 m^2 or treatment with dialysis. Acute kidney injury is often classified by cause: prerenal, from reduced kidney blood flow such as blood or fluid loss; intrinsic, from injury within kidney tissue such as glomerulonephritis, sepsis, toxins, prolonged ischemia, or myoglobin casts; or postrenal, from blocked urine outflow such as stones, tumors, an enlarged prostate, strictures, or catheter blockage.

Kidney Function Test

Singular variant; see *Kidney Function Tests*.

Kidney Function Tests

Blood and urine tests used to assess how well the kidneys remove waste and control fluid and salts. Common measures include creatinine, estimated filtration rate, urine protein, and urinalysis.

Kidney Infection

An infection of one or both kidneys, usually caused by bacteria that travel upward from the bladder. It can cause fever, chills, side or back pain, nausea, vomiting, and painful urination and may lead to sepsis.

Kidney Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the kidney that may be noncancerous or cancerous. It may cause blood in the urine, pain, a lump, weight loss, or no symptoms; imaging and sometimes biopsy identify its type and extent.

Kidney Pain

Pain felt in the side or back below the ribs that may be caused by kidney stones, infection, obstruction, inflammation, or referred pain.

Alternate Names:
Nephralgia

Kidney Position

A side-lying position used during surgery in which the waist is gently bent and the side of the body is raised to give access to the kidney and nearby tissues.

Kidney Removal

Surgery to remove part or all of a kidney, usually for cancer, severe damage, infection, or a nonfunctioning kidney. The remaining kidney may provide adequate function, but bleeding, infection, injury to nearby organs, or reduced kidney function can occur.

Kidney Replacement Therapy

Treatment used when the kidneys cannot adequately remove waste or maintain fluid, electrolyte, and acid-base balance. It supports or replaces some kidney functions through dialysis (hemodialysis, peritoneal dialysis, or continuous kidney replacement therapy) or kidney transplantation. Dialysis may be temporary or ongoing; transplantation provides a functioning donor kidney.

Alternate Names:
KRT; Renal Replacement Therapy; Renal-Replacement Therapy; RRT

Kidney Stone

A hard pebble-like deposit of minerals and acid salts that forms inside the kidneys when urine becomes too concentrated. As fluid volume decreases, substances like calcium, oxalate, and uric acid crystallize and clump together. While small stones may pass unnoticed in the urine, larger stones can lodge in the urinary tract, causing sudden, excruciating pain in the back or side, pink or red blood in the urine, nausea, and painful urination.

Alternate Names:
Renal Calculus; Nephrolithiasis; Urolithiasis

Kidney Stones

Plural form; see *Kidney Stone*.

Kidney Stone Removal

Therapeutic procedures to extract, fragment, or eliminate renal calculi, including percutaneous nephrolithotomy, ureteroscopy, and shockwave lithotripsy; see *Percutaneous Nephrolithotomy*, *Extracorporeal Shock Wave Lithotripsy*, and *Ureteroscopy*.

Kidney Stones In Children

Mineral deposits that form in a child's kidney or urinary tract. They may cause side or abdominal pain, blood in the urine, nausea, vomiting, urinary symptoms, or infection, but some cause no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Nephrolithiasis; Pediatric Urolithiasis; Pediatric Renal Calculi

Kidney Transplant

Surgical placement of a healthy donor kidney into a person with kidney failure to restore renal function. Lifelong immunosuppressive treatment is generally required to reduce rejection risk.

Kidney Transplantation

Alternate name; see *Kidney Transplant*.

Kidney Transplant Rejection

An immune attack that damages a transplanted kidney. It may occur suddenly or gradually and can cause reduced urine, swelling, high blood pressure, or worsening blood tests; treatment depends on the type and severity.

Kidney Trauma

Alternate name for renal trauma, an injury to the kidney caused by blunt or penetrating force.

Kienbock Disease

Avascular necrosis and progressive structural damage of the lunate, a small bone in the wrist, which may lead to collapse. No single cause is established; altered perfusion, anatomic factors, and mechanical loading may contribute. The condition can cause wrist pain, swelling, stiffness, and reduced grip strength. Imaging stage and any secondary arthritis describe the extent of lunate and wrist damage.

Kieselguhr

Diatomaceous earth containing substantial silica; inhalation of its dust can produce occupational pneumoconiosis and other lung injury.

Kiesselbach Plexus

A network of small arteries on the front part of the nasal septum and a common source of nosebleeds.

Alternate Names:
Little Area; Kiesselbach's Plexus

Kiesselbach Triangle

Alternate name; see *Kiesselbach Plexus*.

Kikuchi Disease

A usually short-term inflammation of the lymph nodes, most often in the neck, with no known cause. It mainly affects young adults and may cause tender swollen nodes, fever, night sweats, and a low white-blood-cell count.

Alternate Names:
Histiocytic Necrotizing Lymphadenitis

Kikuchi-Fujimoto Disease

Alternate name; see *Kikuchi Disease*.

Killer Cold Virus

Informal name sometimes used for adenovirus type 14, a virus linked to outbreaks of severe respiratory illness; see *Adenovirus*.

Killian's Triangle

Alternate name; see *Killian Triangle*.

Killian Triangle

A weak area in the back wall of the throat between two parts of the swallowing muscle. A pouch called a Zenker diverticulum can form through this area.

Alternate Names:
Killian Dehiscence

Killip Classification

A four-level system for describing heart failure during a heart attack. The levels range from no signs of heart failure to lung fluid buildup and, at the most severe level, shock caused by the heart's inability to pump enough blood.

Kilocalorie

A unit of energy equal to 1,000 small calories; the dietary Calorie, written with a capital C, is one kilocalorie.

Kilojoule

The SI unit of energy, equal to 1,000 joules; approximately 4.184 kilojoules equal one kilocalorie.

Kimmelstiel-Wilson Lesion

A round area of thickened tissue in a kidney filter that can occur with long-standing diabetes. It is a sign of diabetic kidney damage and may occur with protein in the urine or reduced kidney function.

Alternate Names:
Nodular Diabetic Glomerulosclerosis; Kimmelstiel-Wilson Nodules

Kimmelstiel-Wilson Nodules

Alternate name; see *Kimmelstiel-Wilson Lesion*.

Kimmelstiel-Wilson Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Kimmelstiel-Wilson Lesion*.

Kimura Disease

A rare long-term immune disorder causing painless lumps under the skin, usually in the head or neck, enlarged nearby lymph nodes, and high levels of eosinophils or IgE. It can sometimes affect the kidneys.

Kinase

An enzyme that attaches a small chemical group called a phosphate to another molecule. This acts like a switch controlling cell growth, energy use, movement, communication, and many other processes.

Kinase Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks one or more kinases, enzymes that control cell signals. Some kinase inhibitors are used to treat cancers or other diseases in which these signals are overactive.

Kinesia Paradoxa

A brief, unexpected ability to move normally or quickly in a person who usually has severe slow-

ness or difficulty moving, as can occur in advanced Parkinson disease. It may happen during a strong emotional experience or in response to an urgent situation.

Alternate Names:
Paradoxical Kinesia; Paradoxical Movement

Kinesiology

The study of human movement and the forces produced by muscles, joints, and other body structures. It is used in biomechanics, rehabilitation, exercise science, and the assessment of movement and physical function.

Kinesthesia

The sense of how the body's parts are moving and where they are positioned, even when the eyes are closed. Information from muscles, joints, and skin helps the brain control posture, balance, and coordinated movement.

Kinetics

The study of how a process changes over time. In medicine, pharmacokinetics describes how the body absorbs, distributes, changes, and removes a medicine, helping determine its dose and timing.

Kinetochore

A protein structure assembled at the centromere of each chromosome. It attaches the chromosome to spindle fibers during cell division, helping the chromosomes separate into new cells.

Kingella

Kingella is a genus of bacteria that can live in the mouth and can occasionally cause bloodstream, bone, joint, or heart-valve infections.

Kingella Denitrificans

Kingella denitrificans is a rare bacterium found mainly in the upper airway; it can occasionally cause invasive infection.

Kingella Kingae

Kingella kingae is a bacterium that can cause bone or joint infection, especially in young children, and can rarely cause endocarditis.

Kingella Oralis

Kingella oralis is a mouth-associated bacterium that rarely causes invasive infection, including bloodstream infection or endocarditis.

Kingella Potus

Kingella potus is a rare bacterium that has been associated with occasional human infections; clinical importance depends on the specimen and evidence of true infection.

King's College Criteria

Prognostic criteria used in acute liver failure to identify people at high risk of death without transplantation. For acetaminophen-related failure, criteria include arterial pH below 7.30 after resuscitation or all of: international normalized ratio (INR) above 6.5, creatinine above 3.4 mg/dL, and grade III or IV hepatic encephalopathy. For other causes, they include INR above 6.5 or at least three factors: age under 10 or over 40 years, jaundice more than seven days before encephalopathy, bilirubin above 17.4 mg/dL, INR above 3.5, or an unfavorable cause such as drug-induced liver injury.

Kinin

A group of powerful chemical messenger proteins in the blood and body tissues, most notably bradykinin. Kinins play major roles in the body's inflammatory response by causing blood vessels to widen, increasing vessel permeability (leading to swelling and fluid leakage), and stimulating pain receptors at sites of tissue injury or allergic reactions.

Kinin-Kallikrein System

Alternate name; see *Kallikrein-Kinin System*.

Kinins

Plural form; see *Kinin*.

Kinocilium

A specialized hair-like structure on certain sensory

cells, especially in the inner ear. It helps the cell detect the direction of movement and contributes to balance and hearing signals.

Kissing Disease

Informal term; see *Infectious Mononucleosis*.

Kite Angle

An angle measured on a front-view X-ray of the foot between the talus and heel bone. It helps assess hindfoot alignment, including in clubfoot.

Alternate Names:
AP Talocalcaneal Angle

Klatskin Tumor

A cancer arising where the right and left bile ducts join near the liver. It can block bile flow and cause jaundice, itching, pale stools, or weight loss.

Klebsiella

A genus of Gram-negative bacteria that can cause pneumonia, urinary-tract infection, bloodstream infection, and other healthcare-associated infections.

Klebsiella Aerogenes

A Gram-negative bacterium that can cause urinary, lung, wound, abdominal, or bloodstream infections, especially in healthcare settings. Some strains resist multiple antibiotics. The former name is *Enterobacter aerogenes*.

Alternate Names:
Enterobacter Aerogenes; Klebsiella Mobilis

Klebsiella Oxytoca

Klebsiella oxytoca is a bacterium that can cause urinary, bloodstream, wound, and hospital-acquired infections and can sometimes cause antibiotic-associated hemorrhagic colitis.

Klebsiella Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by Klebsiella bacteria. It can cause fever, cough, chest pain, breathlessness, and sometimes thick or blood-stained sputum; severe infection may destroy lung tissue and is more likely in people with serious illness or weakened defenses.

Klebsiella Pneumoniae

Klebsiella pneumoniae is a bacterium that can cause pneumonia, urinary infection, bloodstream infection, and liver abscess; some strains are highly antibiotic-resistant.

Klebsiella Rhinoscleromatis

A gram-negative bacillus causing chronic granulomatous infection of the nasal passages and upper airway, leading to rhinoscleroma with progressive nasal obstruction and tissue destruction.

Klebsiella Singaporensis

Klebsiella singaporensis is a rare environmental bacterium that has occasionally been recovered from human clinical specimens; its significance depends on the specimen and symptoms.

Klebsiella Variicola

Klebsiella variicola is a bacterium closely related to K. pneumoniae that can cause human infections, including bloodstream and urinary infections.

Kleihauer-Betke Test

A blood test that estimates how much fetal blood has entered a pregnant person's bloodstream. It can help assess bleeding between fetal and maternal circulations and guide the dose of Rh immune globulin when needed.

Alternate Names:
Acid Elution Test; Fetomaternal Hemorrhage Assay

Kleine-Levin Syndrome

A rare disorder causing repeated episodes of excessive sleep, often with confusion, reduced activity, and changes in behavior or appetite. Episodes last days to weeks and are separated by periods of more typical function.

Kleptomania

A mental-health disorder involving recurrent inability to resist impulses to steal items that are not needed for personal use or monetary value. The acts are typically preceded by rising tension and followed by relief or gratification, and cause distress

or impairment.

Alternate Names:
Compulsive Stealing Pathological Stealing

Klinefelter's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Klinefelter Syndrome*.

Klinefelter Syndrome

A genetic condition occurring in males born with an extra X chromosome (most commonly an XXY chromosome pattern instead of the typical XY). Because the extra chromosome affects testicular development, the testes produce lower levels of testosterone. Characteristics can include taller-than-average height, reduced muscle mass, less body and facial hair, enlarged breast tissue (gynecomastia), and infertility, though many boys and men have mild symptoms and remain undiagnosed until adulthood.

Alternate Names:
47,XXY Syndrome; XXY Syndrome

Klippel-Feil Syndrome

A condition present from birth in which two or more neck bones are joined together. It may cause a short neck, low hairline, limited neck movement, hearing loss, or spinal and kidney problems.

Klippel-Trenaunay Syndrome

A rare congenital disorder characterized by abnormal blood and lymph vessel development that affects the growth of soft tissue and bone, typically in one leg or arm. Its hallmark features include a distinctive reddish-purple birthmark (port-wine stain) on the skin, abnormally swollen and twisted veins (varicosities), and overgrowth of the affected limb, making it larger or longer than the opposite limb.

Alternate Names:
KTS; Klippel-Trénaunay Syndrome; Angio-Osteohypertrophy Syndrome

Klippel-Trenaunay-Weber Syndrome

Older name sometimes used for Klippel-Trenaunay syndrome. The name can be confused with Parkes-Weber syndrome, a distinct condition that includes abnormal connections between arteries and veins; see *Klippel-Trenaunay Syndrome*.

Klüver-Bucy Syndrome

A rare brain disorder caused by damage to both temporal lobes. It can cause reduced fear, unusual eating or sexual behavior, a tendency to put objects in the mouth, and difficulty recognizing what is seen.

Alternate Names:
Kluver-Bucy Syndrome; Bilateral Amygdala Ablation Syndrome

Klumpke Palsy

An injury to the lower part of the nerve network that supplies the arm and hand, usually involving the C8 and T1 nerve roots. It can cause hand weakness or numbness and sometimes drooping of an eyelid and a smaller pupil on the same side.

Alternate Names:
Klumpke-Dejerine Palsy; Lower Trunk Brachial Plexus Injury

Klumpke Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Klumpke Palsy*.

Klumpke's Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Klumpke Palsy*.

Kluyvera

A genus of gram-negative bacteria in the Enterobacterales group; species can rarely cause opportunistic human infections.

Kluyvera Ascorbata

A gram-negative Kluyvera species found in the environment and occasionally associated with urinary, bloodstream, or other opportunistic infections.

Kluyvera Cryocrescens

A gram-negative environmental bacterium that rarely causes opportunistic human infection.

Kluyvera Georgiana

A rarely encountered Gram-negative Kluyvera

species that may appear in clinical samples. It can occasionally cause opportunistic infection, especially in people with serious illness, weakened defenses, or invasive medical devices.

Kluyvera Intermedia

A Gram-negative bacterium occasionally found in human samples and rarely causing opportunistic urinary, wound, bloodstream, or other infections.

Knee

The joint between the thighbone, shinbone, and kneecap. It bends and straightens the leg and is supported by ligaments, cartilage, muscles, and tendons.

Knee Arthroplasty

Alternate name; see *Knee Replacement*.

Knee Arthroscopy

A procedure in which a small camera and instruments are inserted through small cuts to examine or treat problems inside the knee joint.

Knee Bursitis

Inflammation of one of the small fluid-filled sacs around the knee. It can cause local pain, tenderness, or swelling, often worse with movement or pressure.

Kneecap

A flat, rounded bone at the front of the knee, embedded in the tendon of the thigh muscles. It protects the joint and improves the leverage used to straighten the knee; injury or arthritis can cause pain and restricted movement.

Kneecap Dislocation

An injury in which the kneecap slips completely out of the groove at the end of the thighbone, usually toward the outside. It causes sudden pain, swelling, and difficulty moving the knee.

Kneecap Instability

Recurrent or persistent abnormal movement of the patella within or out of the femoral groove, causing pain, giving way, or dislocation; assessment may include examination and imaging.

Kneecap Tracking Disorder

Abnormal alignment or movement of the patella during knee bending and straightening, sometimes causing front-of-knee pain, grinding, or instability.

Knee-Chest Position

A position in which a person rests on the knees and chest with the hips bent. It is used for some spinal or anorectal procedures.

Knee CT Scan

A detailed X-ray scan of the knee made by a computer. It is useful for complex fractures, bone alignment, arthritis, infection, masses, and selected soft-tissue problems, but it exposes the person to more radiation than a plain X-ray.

Knee Dislocation

A complete displacement of the shinbone from its normal position beneath the thighbone. It usually tears several ligaments and can injure a major artery or nerve behind the knee.

Knee Disorders

Problems affecting the knee joint, including injuries to ligaments or menisci, arthritis, bursitis, tendon disorders, infection, and fractures. They may cause pain, swelling, stiffness, instability, locking, or difficulty bearing weight.

Knee Effusion

An abnormal buildup of fluid inside the knee joint. It can cause swelling, stiffness, and limited movement and may result from injury, arthritis, bleeding, or infection.

Knee Hyperextension

Bending the knee backward beyond its normal range. It can strain or tear ligaments and may cause pain, swelling, instability, or difficulty bearing weight.

Knee Injury And Meniscus Tears

A meniscus tear is damage to one of the cartilage pads between the thighbone and shinbone, often from twisting or gradual wear. It may cause knee pain, swelling, catching, or locking.

Knee-Jerk

Alternate name; see *Knee Jerk Reflex*.

Knee Jerk Reflex

The automatic straightening of the lower leg when the tendon below the kneecap is tapped. It tests nerves that connect the thigh muscles with the lower spinal cord.

Alternate Names:
Patellar Reflex; Quadriceps Reflex

Knee Joint

Alternate name; see *Knee*.

Knee Joint Replacement

Alternate name; see *Knee Replacement*.

Knee Meniscus

One of two crescent-shaped pads of cartilage between the thighbone and shinbone. The menisci help spread weight, absorb shock, and stabilize the knee.

Knee Microfracture Surgery

An operation that makes small holes in the bone beneath a damaged area of knee cartilage so marrow cells can form repair tissue. It may improve symptoms in selected small defects, but the new tissue is not identical to normal cartilage and results vary.

Knee MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the knee using a magnetic field and radio waves to evaluate cartilage, menisci, ligaments, tendons, bone marrow, muscles, and joint fluid.

Knee Pain

Pain felt in or around the knee, commonly caused by injury, osteoarthritis, bursitis, tendinitis, or inflammatory disease. Swelling, instability, inability to bear weight, or fever may also occur.

Alternate Names:
Gonalgia; Knee Arthralgia

Knee Prosthesis

An artificial joint component used to replace damaged surfaces of the knee, usually including femoral and tibial components and sometimes a patellar component.

Knee Replacement

An operation that replaces part or all of a damaged knee joint with artificial parts, usually to reduce pain and improve movement. It is commonly performed for severe arthritis.

Knee Replacement Surgery

Alternate name; see *Knee Replacement*.

Kniest Dysplasia

A rare inherited disorder of bone and cartilage growth that causes short stature, enlarged joints, unusual facial features, and progressive joint problems. Some people also develop serious eye, hearing, or breathing complications.

Knife-Cut Ulcers From Crohn'S Disease

Deep, linear skin ulcers or fissures associated with Crohn disease, often in the groin, genital, or perianal area. They can occur with or without active intestinal disease and may be an early sign of Crohn disease.

Knock-Knee

Alternate form; see *Knock Knees*.

Knock Knees

Medial angulation of the knees causing the knees to touch while the ankles remain apart, also called genu valgum. It is common during childhood development but may be pathologic when severe, asymmetric, persistent, or associated with pain or growth disturbance.

Alternate Names:

Genu Valgum

Knotless Anchor

A small surgical anchor securing sutures in bone without requiring tied knots. Orthopedic surgeons use it to repair tendons, ligaments, or other soft tissues, with risks including loosening, infection, or tissue failure.

Knuckle

A projecting finger joint, usually a metacarpophalangeal joint; it may be affected by trauma, inflammation, or arthritis.

Knuckle Pad

A firm, usually painless thickening of skin and tissue over a finger joint. It is commonly related to repeated pressure or a fibrous tissue change and is generally harmless.

Kocher Clamp

A surgical clamp with toothed ends that grip tissue or blood vessels firmly.

Kocher-Debre-Semelaigne Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Kocher-Debré-Sémélaigne Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
Hypothyroid Muscular Pseudohypertrophy; Debré-Sémélaigne Syndrome

Kocher-Debré-Sémélaigne Syndrome

A rare complication of severe, long-term underactive thyroid disease in a child. Muscles may look unusually large but be weak or stiff, with slow reflexes and delayed growth.

Alternate Names:
Infantile Hypothyroid Myopathy

Kocher Incision

A diagonal cut made below the right ribs to reach the gallbladder or bile ducts during surgery.

Kocher Maneuver

A surgical technique that frees the first part of the small intestine and the nearby pancreas from the back wall of the abdomen, allowing access to structures behind them.

Alternate Names:
Duodenal Mobilization; Kocherization

Koch's Bacillus

The bacterium that causes tuberculosis, an infection most often affecting the lungs but capable of involving many organs.

Alternate Names:
Tubercle Bacillus; M. tuberculosis

Koebnerisation

Alternate spelling; see *Koebner Phenomenon*.

Koebner Phenomenon

The appearance of a skin condition, such as psoriasis or vitiligo, at a site of skin injury or repeated rubbing.

Kohler Disease

A childhood condition in which the navicular bone in the middle of the foot temporarily loses some of its blood supply. It may cause pain on the inner side of the foot and a limp.

Alternate Names:
Kohler Bone Disease

KOH Preparation

A test in which a skin, hair, or nail sample is treated with potassium hydroxide and viewed under a microscope to look for fungi. A negative result does not always rule out infection if the sample is small or treatment has already begun.

Koilocyte

A cell with changes often seen after infection with human papillomavirus (HPV). Under a microscope, it has an enlarged or irregular nucleus and a clear space around the nucleus. The finding supports HPV-related change but is not enough by itself to determine the diagnosis.

Koilonychia

Thin, brittle nails that become concave and curve upward at the edges, giving them a spoon-like shape. It is often linked to iron deficiency but can also result from poor nutrition, repeated injury, inherited conditions, or other illness; widespread changes may reflect an underlying condition.

Koilonychia (Spoon Nails)

Alternate name; see *Koilonychia*.

Kombucha

A fermented tea made with a culture of bacteria and yeast. It may contain sugar, acids, caffeine, and a small amount of alcohol; contaminated or excessive products can cause illness, especially in vulnerable people.

Konno Procedure

Open-heart surgery to widen a severely narrowed path through which blood leaves the left ventricle. The surgeon enlarges the area below and around the aortic valve, often replacing or repairing the valve at the same time. It is used for complex or recurrent obstruction and carries the usual risks of major heart surgery.

Alternate Names:
Konno-Rastan Procedure; Aortoventriculoplasty

Koplik Spots

Tiny, clustered white or bluish-white spots that look like small grains of salt on a bright red background, appearing on the inside lining of the cheeks opposite the molars. They are an early, unmistakable physical sign of measles, typically appearing one to two days before the characteristic red measles body rash breaks out.

Koplik's Spots

Alternate name; see *Koplik Spots*.

Korotkoff Sounds

Sounds heard through a stethoscope over an artery as a blood-pressure cuff is deflated; their appearance and disappearance are used to estimate systolic and diastolic pressure.

Korsakoff's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Korsakoff Syndrome*.

Korsakoff Syndrome

A long-lasting memory disorder caused by severe thiamine (vitamin B1) deficiency, often associated with alcohol-use disorder. It impairs the ability to form new memories and may cause gaps in past memory that a person unknowingly fills with imagined details.

Kostmann Syndrome

A rare inherited condition in which the bone marrow makes very few neutrophils, a type of white blood cell that fights bacteria. It begins in infancy and causes repeated, sometimes severe infections.

Alternate Names:
Severe Congenital Neutropenia Type 3; Infantile Genetic Agranulocytosis

Koumpounophobia

A strong, persistent fear of buttons that causes significant distress or interferes with daily life. It is a type of specific phobia.

Kounis Syndrome

An acute coronary syndrome triggered by an allergic, hypersensitivity, or anaphylactic reaction. Mast-cell mediators may cause coronary vasospasm, promote plaque erosion or rupture in pre-existing coronary disease, or contribute to stent thrombosis. It can cause myocardial ischemia with or without infarction and may occur alongside skin, respiratory, or circulatory features of hypersensitivity.

KP

Abbreviation; see *Keratosis Pilaris*.

Krabbe Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which missing enzymes damage myelin, the protective covering of nerves. Early disease can cause irritability, stiffness, seizures, loss of skills, and progressive problems with move-

ment, vision, or development.

Krabbe's Disease

Alternate name; see *Krabbe Disease*.

KRAS Gene

A gene that helps control cell growth and division. Certain changes can keep its growth signal switched on, contributing to cancers and affecting which targeted treatments are likely to work.

Kratom

A plant product containing mitragynine and related compounds that can have stimulant or opioid-like effects. It can cause dependence, withdrawal, sedation, seizures, liver injury, and dangerous interactions, especially with other sedatives or opioids.

Kraurosis

Older term for lichen sclerosus, especially when affecting the vulva; see *Lichen Sclerosus*.

Kraurosis Vulvae

Older term for lichen sclerosus affecting the vulva; see *Lichen Sclerosus*.

Krebs Cycle

A series of chemical reactions in mitochondria that oxidizes acetyl-CoA and generates energy-rich molecules used for cellular energy production.

Alternate Names:
Tricarboxylic Acid Cycle; TCA Cycle

Kringles

Small folded parts of certain proteins that help them attach to other molecules. They are found in proteins involved in blood clot breakdown and in some growth signals.

Krukenberg Spindle

A vertical, spindle-shaped band of pigment deposited on the corneal endothelium, the inner surface of the cornea. It is associated with pigment dispersion in the eye and may occur with increased eye pressure.

Alternate Names:
Endothelial Pigment Spindle; Pigment Dispersion Corneal Spindle

Krukenberg's Tumor

Alternate spelling; see *Krukenberg Tumor*.

Krukenberg Tumor

A metastatic ovarian carcinoma characterized by mucin-filled signet-ring cells, most often spread from the stomach and less often from another part of the digestive tract or breast. It commonly affects both ovaries and may cause abdominal swelling, pain, or menstrual changes.

Kt/V

A number used to estimate how much urea a dialysis treatment removes. It combines the dialyzer's cleaning ability and treatment time with the person's body-water volume; clinicians use it with symptoms, fluid balance, laboratory results, and the dialysis schedule.

KTW Syndrome

Abbreviation; see *Klippel-Trenaunay Syndrome*.

Kugelberg-Welander Disease

A milder form of inherited spinal muscular atrophy, also called type 3 spinal muscular atrophy. It usually begins after 18 months of age and causes slowly worsening weakness in muscles close to the body, especially the hips and thighs. Children may have a waddling walk or trouble climbing stairs. Many walk independently, and life expectancy is often near normal with current care.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Muscular Atrophy Type 3 (SMA 3); Juvenile Spinal Muscular Atrophy

Kulchitsky Cells

In the gastrointestinal tract, these are serotonin-secreting enterochromaffin cells, a type of enteroendocrine cell. Their granules react to silver-based stains, so they are also called argentaffin cells. The name has also been used for related but distinct pulmonary neuroendocrine cells.

Alternate Names:
EC Cells; Argentaffin Cells

Kupffer Cells

Immune cells lining the small blood channels in the liver. They remove old blood cells, particles, and some germs from blood coming from the digestive organs.

Kupffer's Cell

Alternate form; see *Kupffer Cells*.

Kuru

A rare, fatal prion disease historically linked to ritual cannibalism. It causes worsening problems with balance and coordination, tremor, and other neurologic changes.

Kussmaul Breathing

A distinct, abnormal pattern of deep, rapid, and labored breathing that occurs when the body's blood becomes dangerously acidic (severe metabolic acidosis). Named after the physician who first described it, this involuntary breathing pattern is the body's automatic attempt to blow off excess carbon dioxide gas through the lungs to reduce blood acidity, commonly seen in severe diabetes crises (diabetic ketoacidosis) or kidney failure.

Kussmaul Respiration

Alternate name; see *Kussmaul Breathing*.

Kussmaul Sign

A rise or failure to fall in the pressure of the large neck veins during breathing in. It suggests that the right side of the heart cannot fill normally and may occur with severe heart failure, constrictive pericarditis, or other conditions affecting right-heart filling.

Kveim-Siltzbach Test

An old skin test once used to support the diagnosis of sarcoidosis. Material from sarcoid tissue was injected under the skin and the area was later biopsied. The test is rarely used now because of safety, availability, and accuracy concerns.

Alternate Names:
Kveim Test; Sarcoidosis Skin Test

Kwashiorkor

A form of severe acute malnutrition marked by swelling in both feet that leaves a dent when pressed; swelling may spread to the legs or other parts of the body. Poor growth, muscle wasting, skin or hair changes, and reduced ability to fight infection may also occur. Its causes are complex and are not explained by protein deficiency alone.

Kyasanur Forest Disease

A viral illness spread by ticks in parts of India. It can cause fever, headache, and muscle pain; severe cases may involve bleeding or inflammation of the brain.

Alternate Names:
KFD; Monkey Fever; Kyasanur Forest Disease Virus Infection

Kynurenine

A substance made when the body breaks down the amino acid tryptophan. It is involved in chemical signaling in the brain and immune system and may change during infection, inflammation, or some diseases.

Kyphoplasty

A minimally invasive procedure that uses a balloon to create space in a collapsed vertebral body and then injects bone cement to stabilize a painful compression fracture.

Kyphoscoliosis

A combination of sideways curvature and excessive forward rounding of the spine. Severe deformity can reduce chest movement and lung capacity, causing breathlessness or, over time, breathing failure and high blood pressure in the lung arteries.

Kyphosis

Excessive forward rounding of the thoracic spine; a degree of this curve is normal. Causes include poor

posture, Scheuermann disease, congenital vertebral changes, degeneration, or compression fractures, often related to osteoporosis. It may cause back pain or stiffness; severe curvature can restrict breathing.

Alternate Names:
Round Back

Kyrle Disease

A rare skin condition that causes large, intensely itchy bumps with hard centers. It is often associated with diabetes or chronic kidney disease.

Kytococcus

A genus of gram-positive cocci found on skin and in the environment that can rarely cause opportunistic infection.

Kytococcus Sedentarius

A skin-associated gram-positive coccus that produces enzymes linked to pitted keratolysis and can rarely cause invasive infection.

L

LAAO

Alternate name; see *Left Atrial Appendage Occlusion*.

Labbe Vein

The inferior anastomotic vein of the cerebral cortex that traverses the surface of the temporal lobe, establishing an anastomotic venous connection between the superficial middle cerebral vein (Sylvian vein) and the transverse dural venous sinus.

Alternate Names:
Inferior Anastomotic Vein; Vein of Labbé

Labetalol

A medicine that lowers blood pressure by slowing the heart and relaxing blood vessels. It is also used for severe high blood pressure during pregnancy and may cause a slow heartbeat, low blood pressure, or breathing problems in people with asthma.

Labhart-Willi Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Prader-Willi Syndrome*.

Labia

The folds of skin surrounding the entrance to the vagina and urethra, consisting mainly of the labia majora and labia minora.

Labial Sounds

Speech sounds made with one or both lips, such as the sounds in “p,” “b,” and “m.” Difficulty making them may occur with problems affecting the lips, mouth, nerves, or speech muscles.

Labia Majora

The paired outer folds of skin of the vulva that help protect the urethral and vaginal openings and contain connective tissue, glands, and fat.

Labia Minora

The paired inner folds of tissue of the vulva, lying within the labia majora and surrounding the vestibule and its openings.

Labiaplasty

Surgical reshaping or reduction of the labia, usually the labia minora, performed for functional symptoms, reconstruction, or selected cosmetic indications. Risks include pain, bleeding, infection, scarring, and altered sensation.

Labile

Easily or rapidly changing, such as blood pressure, blood sugar, mood, or symptoms. Labile measurements may reflect illness, medicines, stress, hormones, or changing treatment and often require repeated observation.

Labile Hypertension

Blood pressure that changes substantially over short periods. Stress, pain, medicines, illness, and measurement conditions can contribute, so repeated properly performed readings help confirm the pattern.

Lability

A tendency to change easily or unpredictably, such as rapidly shifting emotions or blood pressure. Its medical importance depends on the symptom, sever-

ity, and underlying cause.

Labium

A lip-like anatomical structure; in obstetrics and gynecology, usually one of the labia of the vulva.

Labium Majus

One of the paired outer folds of the vulva containing skin, connective tissue, glands, vessels, and nerves and protecting the more internal genital structures.

Labium Minus

One of the paired inner folds of the vulva bordering the vestibule and helping protect the urethral and vaginal openings.

Labor

The process in which regular contractions open the cervix and lead to delivery of the baby and placenta. It includes the stages of cervical opening, birth of the baby, and delivery of the placenta.

Labor and Delivery

The process of uterine contractions, cervical dilation, birth of the baby, delivery of the placenta, and immediate postpartum care.

Labor and Delivery Complications

Problems arising during labor, birth, or the immediate postpartum period, including abnormal fetal position, prolonged labor, excessive bleeding, infection, hypertensive emergencies, or fetal distress.

Laboratory

A facility or department where clinical specimens are examined using microbiologic, hematologic, chemical, molecular, or other diagnostic methods.

Laboratory Medicine

The medical specialty that performs and interprets tests on blood, tissue, and other specimens. Its disciplines include clinical chemistry, hematology, microbiology, immunology, and molecular diagnostics. Results support diagnosis, screening, prognosis, treatment selection, and monitoring.

Laboratory Procedure

A method used to collect, prepare, examine, or measure a patient sample such as blood, urine, tissue, or a swab. Results can help diagnose disease or guide treatment and are considered alongside clinical findings.

Laboratory Test

An examination of a body fluid, tissue, or other specimen to obtain information for diagnosis, monitoring, screening, or treatment.

Labor Complication

A maternal or fetal problem occurring during labor or delivery, such as abnormal labor progress, hemorrhage, infection, fetal distress, or malpresentation, requiring assessment and management based on the cause.

Labor Dystocia

Labor that progresses more slowly than expected or stops progressing during cervical dilation or the pushing stage. It may result from ineffective uterine contractions, the baby's position or size, or factors involving the pelvis. Assessment considers the stage of labor and maternal and fetal condition.

Labor Pain

Pain caused by uterine contractions, cervical dilation, and stretching of pelvic tissues during labor; its intensity and management vary with labor stage and individual factors.

Labor: Signs And Symptoms

Labor is the process of regular uterine contractions that opens the cervix and leads to birth. Possible signs include increasingly regular contractions, rupture of the membranes, a blood-stained mucus discharge, pelvic pressure, and back pain. Heavy bleeding, reduced fetal movement, severe pain, or other complications may occur.

Labour

The process of childbirth, consisting of regular uterine contractions that cause progressive cervical effacement and dilation, leading to delivery of the

baby and placenta.

Labra

The plural of labrum: tough rings of tissue around certain joint sockets, especially the shoulder and hip. They deepen the socket, improve stability, and help distribute pressure during movement.

Labral Tear

A tear in the fibrocartilaginous rim of a joint socket, commonly the shoulder or hip, causing pain, clicking, instability, or reduced range of motion.

Lab Results

Measurements from blood, urine, tissue, or other specimens used with the history and examination to evaluate health, diagnose disease, monitor treatment, or assess risk; an abnormal result is not a diagnosis by itself.

Labrum

A ring of tough, flexible tissue around the socket of a joint. It deepens and stabilizes the shoulder or hip socket.

Labyrinth

The inner-ear system that contains the cochlea for hearing and the balance organs that sense head movement and position. Disease or injury can cause dizziness, unsteadiness, ringing, or hearing loss.

Labyrinth Disorder

A problem affecting inner-ear hearing or balance structures, potentially causing spinning sensations, nausea, unsteadiness, hearing changes, or abnormal eye movements.

Labyrinthine Membrane

The delicate, fluid-containing system inside the inner ear that contains the organs for hearing and balance. Injury or abnormal fluid pressure can cause dizziness, hearing loss, or ringing in the ear.

Labyrinthine Positional Nystagmus

Involuntary rhythmic eye movements triggered by head position or movement because of abnormal vestibular signaling; evaluation distinguishes peripheral inner-ear causes from central neurologic causes.

Labyrinthitis

Inflammation of the inner ear's hearing and balance parts. It can cause sudden spinning dizziness, unsteadiness, nausea, ringing, and sometimes hearing loss.

Laceration

A torn wound caused by blunt or irregular force. It may involve only the skin or extend into fat, muscle, tendons, nerves, or blood vessels; deep, gaping, dirty, or heavily bleeding wounds may need closure or other treatment.

Laceration Suture and Staple Care

Care of a repaired wound closed with sutures or staples, including protection, cleaning, monitoring for infection or wound separation, and removal when indicated. The approach and timing depend on wound location, closure method, and healing.

Alternate Names:
Suture Aftercare; Staple Aftercare; Laceration Closure Aftercare

Lachman Sign

Alternate name; see *Lachman Test*.

Lachman Test

A knee examination in which the lower leg is gently pulled forward while the knee is slightly bent. Too much movement may suggest an injury to the anterior cruciate ligament.

Lachrymal

Relating to tears or the structures that produce and drain them; also spelled lacrimal.

Lacosamide

An antiseizure medicine used mainly for focal seizures. It may cause dizziness, double vision, poor coordination, or changes in the heart's electrical rhythm.

Lacquer Poisoning

Harm from swallowing or breathing lacquer or its solvents. It may irritate the mouth and lungs, cause dizziness or drowsiness, and cause severe lung injury if liquid enters the lungs.

Lacrimal

Relating to tears or the lacrimal glands and drainage passages.

Lacrimal Apparatus

The glands and passages that make, spread, and drain tears. It includes the tear gland, small openings near the inner eyelids, the tear sac, and the duct that drains tears into the nose.

Lacrimal Disease

A disorder of the tear-producing or tear-draining system, including dry eye, dacryocystitis, obstruction, inflammation, or abnormal tearing.

Lacrimal Duct

A drainage channel that carries tears from the lacrimal sac into the nasal cavity. Blockage can cause watering of the eye, recurrent infection, swelling near the inner corner, or discharge.

Lacrimal Gland

One of two glands above the outer part of the eye that make the watery part of tears. The tears spread across the eye and then drain through passages near the inner corner.

Lacrimal Gland Tumor

A benign or malignant growth arising in the tear-producing lacrimal gland, often causing swelling, pain, or displacement of the eye.

Lacrimal Sac

A small sac at the inner corner of the eye that collects tears before they pass through the lacrimal duct into the nose.

Lacrimation

Production and release of tears by the lacrimal glands; excessive tearing may result from irritation, allergy, infection, or blocked tear drainage.

La Crosse Encephalitis

A mosquito-borne viral encephalitis caused by La Crosse virus, usually affecting children and causing fever, headache, seizures, or altered consciousness.

Lactam

A ring-shaped chemical structure found in some medicines. Beta-lactam antibiotics use this structure to weaken bacterial cell walls, but allergies and bacterial resistance can limit their use.

Lactase

An enzyme in the small intestine that breaks lactose, the natural sugar in milk, into absorbable sugars. Low lactase can cause bloating, cramps, gas, diarrhea, or discomfort after dairy foods.

Lactase Deficiency

Reduced activity of the enzyme lactase in the small intestine. It may cause lactose malabsorption and symptoms of lactose intolerance, but not everyone with low lactase has symptoms.

Lactate

A product of cellular metabolism measured in blood. An increased level may occur with strenuous exercise, impaired oxygen delivery, infection, medicines, liver disease, or other conditions; its significance varies with the clinical context.

Lactate Dehydrogenase

An enzyme found in many body tissues. Its blood level may rise when cells are damaged, but the test does not identify the cause by itself.

Lactate Dehydrogenase Test

A blood test measuring lactate dehydrogenase, an enzyme released when cells are injured; increased activity is nonspecific and may occur with hemolysis, liver disease, muscle injury, infection, or malignancy.

Lactation

The production and release of breast milk after childbirth. Early milk, called colostrum, is followed by mature milk; hormones help make and release the milk.

Alternate Names:
Milk Secretion

Lactational Amenorrhea

The temporary absence of menstrual periods during breastfeeding, often because breastfeeding delays the return of ovulation. As a contraceptive method, it is effective only while the person has no periods, is fully or nearly fully breastfeeding, and is less than six months postpartum.

Lactational Mastitis

Alternate name; see *Mastitis*.

Lactation Disorder

A problem with making, releasing, or transferring breast milk after childbirth. Examples include low supply, excess milk, painful engorgement, mastitis, or difficulty with the baby's latch; assessment considers both parent and infant.

Lactation Nutrition

The nutritional needs of a person who is breastfeeding, including enough energy and nutrients to support their health and milk production.

Lacteals

Tiny lymph vessels in the lining of the small intestine that absorb most digested fats and fat-soluble vitamins. They carry these nutrients through the lymph system before they enter the bloodstream.

Lactic Acid

The protonated form of lactate, a product of normal cellular metabolism. At the body's usual pH, nearly all of this compound is present as lactate rather than lactic acid; blood tests measure lactate.

Lactic Acidosis

A metabolic acidosis in which elevated blood lactate contributes to a low blood pH. It can result from poor oxygen delivery to tissues, impaired lactate use or clearance, some medicines, seizures, or severe illness; an elevated lactate alone is not lactic acidosis.

Lactic Acid Test

A test that measures lactate, usually in blood and sometimes in cerebrospinal fluid. It can help assess lactic acidosis or conditions that raise lactate, but the result alone does not identify the cause.

Lactiferous Duct

A duct that carries milk from a mammary-gland lobe toward and through the nipple. Ducts branch within the breast and open separately at the nipple.

Alternate Names:
Galactophore; Mammary Duct

Lactobacillus

A genus of bacteria that produces lactic acid and normally forms part of the healthy vaginal and intestinal microbiota; some species are used as probiotics.

Lactoferrin

Lactoferrin is an iron-binding glycoprotein in milk and mucosal secretions that limits microbial iron access and contributes to innate immune defense.

Lactose

The principal sugar in milk, composed of glucose and galactose. Lactase in the small intestine digests it.

Lactose Fermentation

The ability of bacteria to break down lactose and produce acid or gas. It is used in the laboratory to help identify different types of bacteria.

Lactose Intolerance

A condition in which the body cannot fully digest lactose, the sugar in milk and dairy products, because it does not make enough lactase. It may cause bloating, gas, abdominal pain, nausea, or diarrhea

after consuming lactose.

Lactose Tolerance Test

A medical test used to determine whether the body can properly digest lactose, the natural sugar found in milk and dairy products. After fasting, the patient drinks a liquid containing lactose, and blood samples are drawn over the next two hours to measure blood sugar levels. If the body makes enough of the enzyme lactase, blood sugar will rise normally as lactose is broken down into glucose; if blood sugar levels fail to rise, it indicates lactose malabsorption or intolerance.

Lactose Tolerance Tests

Plural form; see *Lactose Tolerance Test*.

Lactulose

A medicine that softens stool by drawing water into the bowel. It is also used to lower harmful ammonia levels in some people with severe liver disease. Gas and diarrhea can occur.

Lacuna

A small space or cavity in tissue, such as a space containing an osteocyte in bone.

Lacunar Infarct

A small stroke in a deep part of the brain caused by blockage of one of the small arteries supplying that area. It can affect movement, feeling, speech, or coordination, depending on the location.

Alternate Names:
Lacunar Stroke; Subcortical Small Vessel Infarction

Lacunar Stroke

A small ischemic stroke caused by blockage of a tiny artery deep in the brain, often producing weakness, numbness, clumsiness, or speech problems.

Lacunar Syndromes (Small-Vessel Strokes)

Clinical patterns caused by small deep cerebral infarcts in penetrating-artery territories. Recognized patterns include pure motor hemiparesis, pure sensory stroke, sensorimotor stroke, ataxic hemiparesis, and dysarthria–clumsy-hand syndrome.

Ladd Bands

Abnormal bands of tissue present at birth that can cross and squeeze the first part of the small intestine when the bowel is in an abnormal position. They may cause green vomiting and blockage in an infant and are released during the Ladd procedure.

Alternate Names:
Ladd's Peritoneal Bands; Ladd Fibrous Bands

Ladd Procedure

An operation for a child whose intestines developed in an abnormal position and may twist. The surgeon untwists the intestine, releases bands causing blockage, and broadens its attachment to reduce future twisting.

Alternate Names:
Ladd Operation; Ladd's Procedure

Laetrile

A semisynthetic amygdalin-related compound promoted as an alternative cancer treatment; credible evidence has not established anticancer benefit, and cyanide poisoning is a serious risk.

Lafora Disease

A rare inherited epilepsy that usually begins during adolescence and progressively worsens. Seizures, brief muscle jerks, visual symptoms, memory problems, and loss of physical or thinking abilities may occur.

Lagophthalmos

Inability to close the eyelids completely. Exposed cornea can become dry, irritated, scratched, infected, or damaged, especially during sleep, so lubricating treatment and protection may be needed.

LAM

Abbreviation for lymphangioleiomyomatosis, a rare cystic lung disease; see *Lymphangioleiomyomatosis*.

LAMA

Usually, a long-acting muscarinic antagonist: an inhaled medicine that blocks signals that tighten the airways and is used mainly for COPD. In some hospital records, LAMA also means “left against medical advice.”

Lambda

A landmark on the back of the skull where two skull seams meet. It is used to describe head shape and the position of nearby structures, especially in newborn examinations and imaging.

Lambert-Eaton Myasthenic Syndrome

An autoimmune disorder in which antibodies reduce calcium entry into nerve endings, weakening the signal to muscles. It causes weakness, often in the hips and shoulders, reduced reflexes, and sometimes dry mouth; strength may briefly improve with repeated movement. It can be associated with small-cell lung cancer.

Lamellar

Made of thin layers or plates. The word may describe the organized layers of mature bone, the skin barrier, or structures in the eye and nervous system. Its exact meaning depends on the body structure being described.

Lamellar Body

A small storage structure inside certain cells that contains layered fats. In lung cells, it stores and releases surfactant, the substance that helps keep the tiny air sacs open.

Lamellar Bone

Mature bone made of organized layers of mineralized tissue. It forms most adult compact and spongy bone and provides strength while being continually remodeled.

Lamellar Ichthyosis

An inherited skin disorder present from birth that causes dry skin covered with large, dark, plate-like scales over much of the body, including the arms and legs. It may reduce sweating and cause overheating, and can affect the hair, nails, eyes, or palms and soles.

Lamin

A structural protein forming part of the nuclear lamina, which supports the inner surface of the cell nucleus.

Lamina

A flat piece of bone that forms part of the back of a vertebra. The two laminae help complete the bony arch around the spinal cord and can be removed during some spine operations.

Lamina Cribrosa

A fenestrated, mesh-like collagenous sheet of the sclera through which unmyelinated axons of retinal ganglion cells exit the eye to form the optic nerve; the primary site of axonal injury and excavation in glaucoma.

Lamina Propria

A thin layer of supporting tissue beneath the inner lining of organs such as the intestine, airways, and bladder. It contains small blood vessels, immune cells, glands, and connective tissue.

Laminectomy

An operation that removes part of a spinal bone to make more room for the spinal cord or nerves. It may be used for spinal narrowing, a tumor, or selected disk problems.

Laminin

A protein in the supporting framework around cells that helps cells attach to underlying tissue. It contributes to tissue structure, development, repair, and the filtering barrier in some organs.

Lamivudine

Lamivudine is a nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor used with other antiretrovirals for HIV and as an antiviral for chronic hepatitis B; resistance and rare lactic acidosis or hepatic complications require monitoring.

Lamotrigine

Lamotrigine is an antiseizure medicine that inhibits voltage-gated sodium channels and is also used for bipolar-maintenance treatment; rapid dose escalation increases the risk of serious rash including Stevens–Johnson syndrome.

Lancet

A small, sterile, usually single-use device with a sharp point used to puncture the skin and obtain a capillary-blood sample. Lancets are commonly used for fingertip glucose testing and other point-of-care blood tests.

Alternate Names:
Blood Lancet; Fingerstick Lancet

Landolt Ring

A ring-shaped symbol with a gap used to test visual sharpness. The person identifies which direction the gap faces; smaller symbols indicate better visual acuity.

Langerhans' Cell

An immune cell in the skin that captures foreign substances and helps activate T-cell responses.

Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

A rare clonal disorder in which abnormal Langerhans-like cells accumulate in tissues and form lesions, commonly in bone, skin, or lungs and sometimes in lymph nodes or the pituitary gland. It may affect one or several organs.

Langerhans-Cell Histiocytosis

Alternate spelling; see *Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis*.

Langerhans Cells

Immune cells in the outer skin that capture foreign substances and help start immune responses. They connect skin defenses with nearby lymph tissue and can contribute to allergic or inflammatory reactions.

Langer Lines

Natural lines of skin tension that reflect the predominant orientation of collagen fibers in the dermis and may influence surgical scar direction.

Language Barrier

Difficulty communicating because a patient and healthcare professional do not share a language well enough for safe understanding. A trained interpreter helps explain symptoms, consent, instructions, and risks.

Language Development

The gradual development of understanding, sounds, words, grammar, and communication during childhood. Delays may be related to hearing loss, developmental conditions, neurologic disease, or limited language exposure.

Language Disorder

A developmental or acquired impairment in understanding, producing, or using spoken, written, or signed language that affects communication and daily function.

Language Therapy

Treatment that improves understanding, expression, reading, writing, or other language skills after developmental or acquired impairment.

Lanolin

Lanolin is a waxy substance derived from sheep wool used as an emollient and in topical products; allergy or irritation can occur.

Lanolin Poisoning

Swallowing a small amount of lanolin, a wool-derived moisturizer, usually causes little more than stomach upset. Large amounts or products with added medicines can cause more serious poisoning.

Lansoprazole

A medicine that strongly reduces stomach acid. It is used for heartburn, ulcers, and some H. pylori infections; long-term use may affect mineral or vitamin levels and infection risk.

Lanthanum

A chemical element whose carbonate salt can bind dietary phosphate and lower phosphate absorption in people with advanced kidney disease.

Lanugo

Fine, soft hair that grows all over the body of a fetus and is typically shed before birth.

Lanugo Hair

Lanugo: the fine, soft, usually unpigmented hair covering a fetus and sometimes present on a premature newborn; it is normally shed before or shortly after birth.

Laparoscope

A slender instrument with a light and camera used to view the abdominal or pelvic cavity through a small incision during minimally invasive surgery.

Laparoscopic Cholecystectomy

Surgical removal of the gallbladder through small abdominal incisions using a laparoscope and instruments, commonly performed for symptomatic gallstones or gallbladder inflammation.

Laparoscopic Colectomy

Laparoscopic colectomy is removal of part or all of the colon through small incisions using a camera and specialized instruments.

Laparoscopic Gallbladder Removal

Surgery to remove the gallbladder through several small abdominal openings using a camera and instruments. It commonly treats symptomatic gallstones or gallbladder inflammation; bleeding, infection, bile leakage, and injury to bile ducts are possible.

Laparoscopic Gastric Banding

A bariatric operation that places an adjustable band around the upper stomach to create a small pouch and restrict food passage; it is less commonly performed than other bariatric procedures.

Laparoscopic Hysterectomy

Removal of the uterus using laparoscopic instruments through small abdominal incisions. The cervix, fallopian tubes, and ovaries may or may not also be removed; the approach and extent depend on the indication, anatomy, and surgical plan.

Laparoscopic Nephrectomy

Removal of part or all of a kidney using a camera and instruments through small incisions. It may be done for cancer, severe kidney disease, or living donation; an adrenal gland is removed only when indicated.

Laparoscopic Surgery

Surgery performed through small cuts using a camera and long instruments. It often causes less pain and faster recovery than open surgery, but still has risks such as bleeding, infection, and injury to nearby organs.

Laparoscopy

Keyhole surgery that uses a small camera and instruments through small cuts in the abdomen or pelvis. It can be used to look for a problem, take a sample, or treat conditions such as appendicitis, gallstones, endometriosis, or an ectopic pregnancy. Recovery is often easier than after open surgery, but risks and recovery time depend on the procedure.

Alternate Names:
Keyhole Surgery; Minimally Invasive Abdominal Surgery; Diagnostic Laparoscopy; Laparoscopic Surgery

Laparotomy

An operation that uses a larger cut in the abdomen to reach the abdominal or pelvic organs.

Lapatinib

Lapatinib is a targeted cancer medicine that blocks HER2 and epidermal-growth-factor receptors and is used for selected advanced breast cancers.

Lapatinib Ditosylate

Lapatinib ditosylate is the salt form of lapatinib, a

targeted medicine used for selected HER2-positive breast cancers.

Laplace Law

A principle describing how pressure, radius, and wall thickness affect tension and stress in a hollow structure. For example, as a heart chamber dilates, its wall must develop greater tension to generate the same pressure.

Large Airway Obstruction

A blockage in the windpipe or large breathing tubes. It can cause noisy breathing, shortness of breath, and difficulty clearing mucus and may be caused by narrowing, a tumor, or weakness of the airway wall.

Large Bowel Obstruction

A blockage in the colon, commonly caused by cancer, twisting of the bowel, scar tissue, or diverticular disease. It can cause increasing swelling, cramping, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Large Bowel Resection

Surgical removal of a segment of the colon or rectum, followed by reconnection of the bowel or creation of a stoma when necessary to treat cancer, obstruction, ischemia, inflammation, or other disease.

Large Colon

In horses, the large colon is a major part of the large intestine where water and electrolytes are absorbed and digestive contents are moved onward.

Large For Gestational Age

A fetus or newborn larger than expected for the number of weeks of pregnancy, usually above the 90th percentile. Maternal diabetes, family size, and excess pregnancy weight gain can contribute and may increase birth complications.

Large Intestine

The final part of the digestive tract, extending from the small intestine to the rectum. It absorbs water and helps form and move stool.

Laron Syndrome

A rare inherited growth disorder in which the body cannot respond properly to growth hormone. It causes severe short stature, characteristic facial features, and very low levels of the growth signal needed for normal bone development.

Larva Currens From Strongyloides

A rapidly moving, itchy skin rash caused by Strongyloides larvae moving through the skin. It often appears around the buttocks or trunk and may indicate ongoing intestinal infection requiring antiparasitic treatment.

Larva Migrans

A condition caused by migrating larval parasites in human tissues, including cutaneous larva migrans in the skin and visceral larva migrans in internal organs.

Laryngeal

Relating to the larynx, the organ in the throat containing the vocal cords and helping protect the airway.

Laryngeal Botulinum Toxin Injection

Targeted electromyography- or laryngoscopy-guided injection of botulinum neurotoxin into specific intrinsic laryngeal muscles (such as the thyroarytenoid or posterior cricoarytenoid) to reduce involuntary spasms in focal laryngeal dystonias, predominantly adductor or abductor spasmodic dysphonia.

Laryngeal Cancer

Cancer of the larynx, or voice box. Tobacco, alcohol, and some HPV infections increase risk. Persistent hoarseness, painful or difficult swallowing, noisy breathing, or a neck lump may occur.

Laryngeal Candidiasis

A yeast infection of the voice box, usually causing hoarseness, throat pain, or difficulty swallowing. It is more likely with weakened immunity or inhaled steroid use and may require examination of the larynx and antifungal treatment.

Laryngeal Carcinoma

Laryngeal carcinoma is cancer arising in the voice box and may cause hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, pain, or breathing problems.

Laryngeal Cartilage

Laryngeal cartilage forms the structural framework of the voice box, maintains the airway, and supports vocal-fold movement.

Laryngeal Cleft

A laryngeal cleft is a congenital opening between the airway and esophagus that can allow aspiration and cause feeding or breathing problems.

Laryngeal Edema

Swelling of the voice box that can narrow the airway and cause hoarseness, a harsh high-pitched noise when breathing in, or difficulty breathing. Causes include allergy, infection, injury, or a breathing tube.

Laryngeal Fistula

An abnormal passage between the voice box and nearby tissue or the swallowing tract. It can allow food or saliva to enter the airway and cause coughing, repeated chest infections, or breathing problems.

Laryngeal Hemorrhage

Bleeding within or around the larynx, which may result from trauma, instrumentation, vocal strain, vascular lesions, infection, or tumor and can threaten the airway.

Laryngeal Masks

Laryngeal masks are supraglottic airway devices placed above the vocal cords to maintain ventilation during anesthesia or emergencies.

Laryngeal Mucositis

Inflammation and open sores in the lining of the voice box, often after radiation, chemotherapy, infection, or irritation. It can cause hoarseness, throat pain, painful swallowing, or breathing difficulty.

Laryngeal Nerve

A branch of the vagus nerve supplying the larynx; injury can cause hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, or breathing problems.

Laryngeal Nerve Damage

Injury to the recurrent or superior laryngeal nerves causing hoarseness, vocal-cord weakness, swallowing difficulty, or airway compromise. Common causes include thyroid or neck surgery, malignancy, trauma, and compression along the nerve pathway.

Laryngeal Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of the laryngeal airway caused by edema, foreign body, tumor, trauma, infection, vocal-cord dysfunction, or other structural disease.

Laryngeal Papillomatosis

A condition in which human papillomavirus (HPV) causes noncancerous, wart-like growths in the voice box or airways. The growths may cause hoarseness or make breathing difficult.

Alternate Names:
Recurrent Respiratory Papillomatosis

Laryngeal Prosthesis

A device used to help restore speech after removal of the larynx, commonly through a one-way valve placed between the trachea and esophagus.

Laryngeal Stridor

A harsh, high-pitched noise caused by turbulent airflow through a narrowed upper airway, often most noticeable during inspiration.

Laryngeal Web

A laryngeal web is a thin membrane across part of the airway, usually congenital or acquired after injury, causing hoarseness or airway narrowing.

Laryngectomee

A person who has undergone laryngectomy, surgical removal of all or part of the larynx; total laryngectomy separates the airway from the mouth and

nose.

Laryngectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the larynx, usually for cancer or severe structural disease. After total removal, breathing occurs permanently through an opening in the neck; partial surgery may preserve some voice and swallowing.

Laryngectomy Tube

A tube placed in the neck opening after larynx surgery to help keep the airway open and allow suctioning or ventilation when needed. Mucus blockage, bleeding, infection, and tissue overgrowth can occur.

Laryngitis

Inflammation of the voice box that causes hoarseness or temporary voice loss. Common causes include viral infection, voice overuse, smoke or other irritation, and reflux.

Laryngocele

An air-filled pouch formed when a small space beside the vocal cords becomes enlarged. It may cause hoarseness, a neck swelling that changes with pressure, coughing, or blockage of the airway.

Laryngomalacia

A birth condition in which soft tissue above an infant's vocal cords partly collapses during breathing in, causing noisy breathing. It often improves with growth, but feeding trouble, pauses in breathing, or poor growth may occur.

Laryngopharyngeal Reflux

Backflow of stomach contents into the throat and voice box. It may cause hoarseness, frequent throat clearing, cough, a lump-like feeling, excess mucus, or throat tightness, often without typical heartburn.

Laryngopharynx

The lower part of the throat behind the voice box, leading to the esophagus. It helps direct swallowed food away from the airway and is a site where some throat cancers can develop.

Laryngoscope

An instrument used to see the throat and vocal cords, especially while placing a breathing tube. Common blades are curved Macintosh and straight Miller types; use can injure teeth, lips, or throat.

Laryngoscopy

An examination of the voice box and nearby throat using a mirror or a thin camera passed through the mouth or nose. It helps investigate hoarseness, swallowing problems, airway narrowing, bleeding, or suspected tumors.

Laryngoscopy And Nasolaryngoscopy

An examination of the voice box and nearby airway using a small rigid or flexible camera passed through the mouth or nose. It helps investigate hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, noisy breathing, bleeding, or a suspected growth.

Laryngospasm

Sudden tightening of the folds inside the voice box that partly or fully blocks breathing. It may be triggered by saliva, blood, reflux, a breathing tube, or anesthesia and can cause choking or difficulty breathing.

Laryngostenosis

Narrowing of the voice box, or larynx, that can restrict breathing. Causes include scarring after intubation, injury, inflammation, tumors, and congenital narrowing; noisy breathing or breathlessness may occur.

Laryngotracheobronchitis

Alternate name; see *Croup*.

Larynx

The voice box in the front of the neck between the throat and windpipe. It contains the vocal cords, produces sound, helps keep food and liquid out of the lungs, and regulates airflow during breathing.

Larynx Cancer

Laryngeal cancer is a malignant tumor of the voice

box and may cause persistent hoarseness, swallowing pain, neck mass, ear pain, cough, or breathing difficulty. Examination and biopsy are used for diagnosis; treatment depends on site and stage.

Alternate Names:
Laryngeal Carcinoma; Cancer of the Voice Box

Larynx Disease

Any disorder affecting the larynx, including inflammation, infection, structural lesions, vocal-cord dysfunction, neurologic disease, or cancer.

Larynx Muscle

A muscle of the voice box that moves the vocal folds and helps protect the airway and produce sound.

Larynx Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the voice box. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, pain, breathing problems, or a neck lump.

Lasegue Sign

A physical examination test for lumbosacral nerve root irritation (radiculopathy / sciatica, particularly L4, L5, or S1); with the patient supine, passive straight leg raising of the symptomatic leg provokes sharp radicular pain radiating down the posterior leg below the knee between 30 and 70 degrees of hip flexion.

Alternate Names:
Straight Leg Raise Test; SLR Test

Laser

A device that produces a concentrated beam of light. Depending on its wavelength and power, it can measure tissue, cut or seal tissue, remove abnormal growths, or treat selected eye and skin conditions.

Laser Ablation

The use of focused laser energy to heat, destroy, or seal targeted tissue. The technique is used in selected vascular, ophthalmic, dermatologic, and other procedures.

Laser-Assisted In Situ Keratomileusis

Alternate name; see *LASIK*.

Laser Assisted Uvula Palatoplasty

A procedure using laser energy to reshape or remove selected soft-palate and uvula tissue, intended mainly to reduce snoring in carefully selected patients.

Alternate Names:
LAUP

Laser Fiber

A thin optical fiber that carries laser energy into the body during treatment. It can break urinary stones, destroy selected tumors, seal blood vessels, or treat other targeted tissues.

Laser Photocoagulation

A laser treatment that seals or destroys leaking or abnormal blood vessels, especially in the retina, helping limit bleeding, swelling, or damaging new vessel growth.

Laser Eye Surgery

Refractive corneal surgeries that use precise excimer or femtosecond lasers to reshape the cornea and correct myopia, hyperopia, or astigmatism; see *LASIK Eye Surgery* and *Refractive Surgery*.

Laser Surgery

Laser surgery uses a focused beam of light to cut, remove, seal, or reshape tissue in selected procedures.

Laser Surgery For The Skin

Use of concentrated light to remove, vaporize, seal, or reshape selected skin tissue. It may treat scars, abnormal blood vessels, unwanted hair, or some lesions; redness, pigment change, burns, scarring, and infection are possible.

Laser Therapy

Laser therapy uses controlled light energy to treat selected skin, eye, vascular, dental, or other medical conditions.

Laser Therapy For Cancer

Use of an intense, focused beam of light to destroy or shrink selected cancer tissue or control bleeding and blockage. It is useful only for certain tumors and sites; treatment may be combined with surgery, medicines, or radiation.

Laser Trabeculoplasty

Alternate name; see *Trabeculoplasty*.

LASIK

Laser-assisted in situ keratomileusis is a refractive surgery in which a corneal flap is created and an excimer laser reshapes the underlying corneal tissue to correct myopia, hyperopia, or astigmatism.

LASIK Eye Surgery

Alternate name; see *LASIK*.

Lassa Fever

A viral illness that can cause fever, weakness, vomiting, bleeding, and damage to several organs. It is usually spread by contact with urine or droppings of infected rodents in parts of West Africa and sometimes by contact with body fluids.

Lassa Virus

An arenavirus that causes Lassa fever, a potentially severe hemorrhagic illness acquired mainly through contact with infected rodent excreta or body fluids.

Lassitude

A state of marked fatigue, weakness, or lack of energy that may occur with systemic illness, anemia, endocrine disease, infection, medication effects, or psychological conditions.

Last Menstrual Period

The first day of the most recent normal menstrual bleeding. Clinicians use it to estimate how many weeks a pregnancy has lasted and the expected delivery date, but the estimate is less reliable with irregular cycles or uncertain dates.

Latanoprost

Latanoprost is a prostaglandin F2-alpha analogue eye drop that increases uveoscleral outflow and lowers intraocular pressure in glaucoma or ocular hypertension; iris pigmentation and eyelash growth may occur.

Latarjet Procedure

Shoulder-stabilization surgery that moves part of the coracoid bone, with attached tissue, to the front edge of the shoulder socket. It helps prevent repeated dislocation when bone loss or failed previous treatment makes other repairs unsuitable.

Late Decelerations

A repeated, gradual slowing of a baby's heart rate that starts after a uterine contraction begins and recovers after the contraction ends. It can indicate reduced oxygen transfer through the placenta during labor.

Late Effects

Health problems appearing months or years after cancer treatment, including heart, lung, hormone, fertility, nerve, bone, or second-cancer complications.

Late Gadolinium Enhancement

A cardiac MRI finding of increased signal in areas where gadolinium contrast has accumulated in expanded extracellular space, often reflecting myocardial scar or fibrosis and sometimes inflammation or infiltration. Its distribution helps characterize the underlying tissue injury.

Alternate Names:
LGE; Delayed Enhancement

Latent

Present but inactive, hidden, or not currently producing symptoms, as in latent tuberculosis infection or a latent virus.

Latent Autoimmune Diabetes In Adults

Diabetes caused by the immune system gradually damaging insulin-producing cells in an adult. It may

first resemble type 2 diabetes, but insulin production usually declines over time and insulin treatment may eventually be needed.

Alternate Names:
Type 1.5 Diabetes; Late-Onset Autoimmune Diabetes of Adulthood

Latent Infection

Persistent infection in which an infectious agent remains in a host in a nonreplicating or intermittently replicating state without active clinical disease. Reactivation can occur when immune control is impaired, as in latent tuberculosis.

Latent Phase Of Labor

The early part of the first stage of labor, beginning with regular contractions and gradual cervical change before active labor. The transition to active labor is assessed clinically, and the duration varies widely between individuals.

Latent Syphilis

Latent syphilis is syphilis infection without current symptoms, identified by testing and classified by duration to guide treatment and follow-up.

Latent Tuberculosis

Infection with *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* without clinical evidence of active tuberculosis disease. People typically have no symptoms and are not infectious, but the infection may later progress to active disease.

Latent Tuberculosis Infection

An immune response to Mycobacterium tuberculosis without clinical or microbiologic evidence of active disease. It is usually asymptomatic and not contagious, but it can reactivate; treatment decisions depend on age, immune status, exposure risk, test results, and drug interactions.

Late-Onset Hypogonadism

A condition in which an older man has symptoms of low testosterone and repeatedly low early-morning blood levels. Symptoms may include reduced sexual desire, erection problems, tiredness, reduced muscle strength, increased body fat, weak bones, or low mood. Other illnesses and medicines can also affect symptoms and testosterone levels.

Alternate Names:
LOH; Age-Related Testosterone Deficiency; Testosterone Deficiency Syndrome

Late Preterm Birth

Births occurring from 34 weeks 0 days through 36 weeks 6 days of gestation. These infants have greater risks than term infants of respiratory, temperature, glucose, jaundice, feeding, and readmission problems.

Alternate Names:
Late Preterm Delivery

Lateral

Toward or located at the side, away from the body's midline. For example, the ears are lateral to the nose; the opposite term is medial.

Lateral Canthotomy And Cantholysis

An emergency operation that opens the outer corner of the eyelids and releases tight supporting tissue around the eye. It lowers dangerous pressure after severe eye injury or bleeding and may protect vision.

Lateral Collateral Ligament Injury

A stretch or tear of the strong ligament on the outer side of the knee, often caused by a blow to the inner knee or a force pushing the lower leg inward. It causes outer-knee pain and may make the knee unstable.

Lateral Cuneiform

One of three small bones in the middle of the foot. It lies between the other cuneiform bones and the cuboid, joins the third toe bone, and helps support the foot's arch.

Lateral Cutaneous Nerve of the Thigh

A sensory nerve arising from the L2 and L3 ventral rami of the lumbar plexus that passes under the lateral end of the inguinal ligament to provide sensation to the anterolateral thigh; entrapment here

causes meralgia paresthetica.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Femoral Cutaneous Nerve; LFCN

Lateral Decubitus Position

A position in which a person lies on either side of the body. The side used depends on the examination or procedure.

Lateral Elbow Tendinopathy

Alternate name; see *Lateral Epicondylitis*.

Lateral Epicondylitis

Pain and irritation of the tendons attached to the outer elbow, often from repeated gripping or wrist movement. Despite the name, it is usually a tendon problem rather than inflammation of the bone attachment alone. Also called *tennis elbow*.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Elbow Tendinopathy

Lateral Epicondylosis

Alternate name; see *Lateral Epicondylitis*.

Lateral Geniculate Nucleus

A laminated thalamic sensory relay nucleus that receives visual information directly from retinal ganglion cell axons via the optic tract and projects through the optic radiations (geniculocalcarine tract) to the primary visual cortex (Brodmann area 17).

Alternate Names:
LGN; Lateral Geniculate Body

Lateral Medullary Syndrome

A stroke in the outer part of the lower brainstem. It may cause dizziness, poor coordination, trouble swallowing or speaking, loss of feeling on one side of the face, and loss of pain or temperature sensation on the opposite side of the body.

Alternate Names:
Wallenberg Syndrome; PICA Syndrome

Lateral Meniscus

The lateral meniscus is a crescent-shaped cartilage pad on the outer side of the knee that distributes load and stabilizes movement.

Lateral Pontine Syndrome

A stroke in the outer part of the bridge-like section of the brainstem. It may cause facial weakness, hearing loss, dizziness, poor coordination, and loss of pain or temperature sensation on the opposite side of the body.

Alternate Names:
Marie-Foix Syndrome; AICA Infarction Syndrome

Lateral Rotation

Turning a limb or body part away from the body's midline. Rotating the hip so the knee and foot point outward is one example; limited or painful movement may indicate injury.

Lateral Sclerosis

Damage affecting nerve pathways along the side of the spinal cord that carry movement signals. It may cause increasing stiffness and weakness, as in some motor-neuron diseases; the exact diagnosis requires the associated clinical findings.

Lateral Traction

Lateral traction is a pulling force applied sideways to a body part to improve alignment, reduce a dislocation, or relieve pressure.

Lateral Ventricle

One of two fluid-filled spaces inside the brain that produce and contain cerebrospinal fluid, helping protect and support the brain.

Lateral X-Ray

An X-ray image taken from the side, providing a lateral view of the body part being examined.

Latex Agglutination Test

A laboratory test in which tiny coated particles clump together when they meet a matching substance. The reaction can help detect selected germs, antibodies, or proteins in a patient sample.

Latex Allergy

An immune-mediated hypersensitivity reaction to natural rubber latex. Contact may cause dermatitis, urticaria, rhinitis, asthma, or anaphylaxis, especially in healthcare and occupational settings.

Alternate Names:
Natural Rubber Latex Allergy; NRL Allergy

Lathyrism

A neurologic disorder caused by prolonged or excessive ingestion of certain Lathyrus legumes, especially grass pea, characterized primarily by progressive spastic weakness of the legs.

Latissimus Dorsi

A broad back muscle that extends and internally rotates the arm and assists movements such as climbing.

Latissimus Dorsi Muscle

A broad muscle covering much of the back that pulls the arm down, backward, and toward the body. It is used in climbing, swimming, and rowing and may also be used to reconstruct tissue during surgery.

Lattice Degeneration

A peripheral retinal degeneration characterized by elongated areas of retinal thinning, pigment changes, and abnormal vessels. It can increase the risk of retinal tears or detachment in some people.

Lavage

Washing a body space, organ, or wound with sterile fluid. It may be used to remove blood, infected material, or harmful substances, or to collect a sample; the method and risks depend on the part of the body treated.

Lavage Fluid

Liquid used to wash a body space, wound, or organ during a medical procedure, or collected afterward for laboratory analysis. Its contents can help detect infection, bleeding, cancer cells, inflammation, or abnormal proteins.

Lawton IADL Scale

A tool measuring ability to manage complex daily tasks such as telephone use, shopping, cooking, housekeeping, transportation, medicines, and finances.

Laxative Overdose

Taking too much laxative can cause severe diarrhea, vomiting, dehydration, and abnormal body salts. Some products can disturb heart rhythms or damage the bowel, especially after large exposures or in children.

Laxatives

Medicines or preparations that help relieve constipation by adding bulk, softening stool, drawing water into the bowel, or stimulating bowel movement. The choice depends on the cause and duration of constipation and the person's health.

Laxatives For Constipation

Laxatives relieve constipation through fiber and water retention, stool softening, osmotic effects, or increased bowel contractions. The suitable type depends on the cause, duration, age, medicines, kidney function, and risk of blockage; persistent bleeding, vomiting, or severe pain may indicate another condition.

Alternate Names:
Aperients; Cathartics; Purgatives

Lazy Eye

Reduced vision caused by abnormal visual development during childhood, usually in one eye but sometimes in both. It may result from eye misalignment, unequal focusing, or an obstruction such as a cataract; the medical term is amblyopia.

Alternate Names:
Amblyopia; Functional Amblyopia

Lazy Eye (Amblyopia)

Alternate name; see *Lazy Eye* and *Amblyopia*.

LCH

Abbreviation for Langerhans cell histiocytosis; see

Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis.

LCIS

Abbreviation; see *Lobular Carcinoma In Situ*.

LDH Isoenzyme Blood Test

A blood test separating lactate dehydrogenase isoenzymes to help suggest the tissue source of an elevated total LDH, although more specific tests are preferred for most conditions.

LDL

Low-density lipoprotein, a blood particle that carries cholesterol to tissues. Too much LDL can contribute to fatty buildup in artery walls and increase the risk of heart attack and stroke; risk-based treatment may lower it.

LDL Cholesterol

Cholesterol carried in low-density lipoprotein particles; high levels contribute to atherosclerosis and cardiovascular risk. See *LDL*.

LDL Test

A blood test measuring low-density lipoprotein cholesterol, a major atherogenic lipoprotein used with the lipid profile to estimate cardiovascular risk and guide lipid-lowering treatment.

L-Dopa

A medicine that the brain converts into dopamine. It is usually combined with carbidopa or benserazide to treat Parkinson disease.

Lead

A toxic heavy metal that can harm the nervous system, blood-forming system, kidneys, cardiovascular system, and reproductive system. Exposure may occur through contaminated paint dust or soil, drinking water, workplaces, hobbies, imported products, or other sources; children and fetuses are especially vulnerable to neurodevelopmental effects.

Lead And Tap Water

Drinking water can become contaminated with lead when it contacts lead-containing service lines, plumbing, fixtures, or solder. Exposure can be reduced through testing, filtration, interim measures, or repair or replacement of the source according to local public-health guidance; boiling water does not remove lead.

Leadless Pacemaker

A small pacemaker placed directly inside a heart chamber without a conventional chest pocket or transvenous lead. It provides pacing for selected slow or unreliable heart rhythms; device selection depends on the person's cardiac anatomy and pacing needs.

Lead Pipe Rigidity

Alternate spelling; see *Lead-Pipe Rigidity*.

Lead-Pipe Rigidity

Smooth, continuous muscle stiffness in which a limb resists movement evenly throughout its range. It can occur in Parkinson disease and other movement disorders.

Alternate Names:
Plastic Rigidity; Extrapyramidal Lead-Pipe Hypertonia

Lead Poisoning

A toxic condition caused by the buildup of lead in the body over time, typically from breathing in lead dust or swallowing lead-based paint chips, contaminated water from old pipes, or contaminated soil. Lead interferes with normal enzyme function, red blood cell production, and nerve signaling. In children, even low levels of exposure can cause permanent learning difficulties, behavioral problems, hearing loss, and slowed growth; in adults, high levels cause high blood pressure, abdominal pain, memory loss, kidney damage, and anemia.

Alternate Names:
Plumbism; Saturnism

Lead-Time Bias

The false appearance that screening improves survival because it finds a disease earlier, even though the person dies at the same time as without earlier

diagnosis.

Lead Toxicity and Nutrition

Adequate nutrition, especially iron and calcium, can help reduce lead absorption in children with deficiencies. Nutrition does not remove lead exposure or replace blood testing and public-health measures to find and stop the source.

Alternate Names:
Nutritional Lead Protection; Dietary Prevention of Lead Absorption

Learned Helplessness

A psychological state resulting from repeated exposure to inescapable, uncontrollable negative events, leading an individual to believe they lack the agency to alter future outcomes, contributing to passivity and depression.

Learned Insomnia

Ongoing difficulty sleeping maintained by worry, sleep-related habits, and learned associations that make the bed or bedtime trigger alertness instead of sleep.

Learning Difficulties

Persistent problems acquiring or using academic skills such as reading, writing, or mathematics, not explained solely by low intelligence or inadequate education.

Learning Disabilities

Persistent difficulties acquiring or using skills such as reading, writing, mathematics, language, attention, or coordination despite appropriate opportunity and instruction; assessment considers development, education, and other neurologic or sensory factors.

Learning Disorder

A neurodevelopmental disorder causing persistent difficulty acquiring or using academic skills such as reading, writing, or mathematics despite appropriate instruction.

Leber Congenital Amaurosis

A rare inherited disorder of the retina that causes severe vision loss from birth or early infancy. Babies may have wandering eye movements, sensitivity to light, or unusual responses of the pupils; genetic testing can help confirm the cause.

Leber Hereditary Optic Neuropathy

An inherited disorder of the energy-producing parts of cells that damages the optic nerves. It usually causes painless, rapidly worsening loss of central vision in one eye followed by the other, often in young adults. The altered mitochondrial DNA is passed through the mother; genetic testing can confirm the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Lhon

Leber's Hereditary Optic Neuropathy

An inherited mitochondrial disorder that causes painless loss of central vision, usually first in one eye and then the other. It mainly affects young men, and genetic counseling and specialist eye care may help.

Lecithin-Sphingomyelin Ratio

A ratio of two substances measured in amniotic fluid that was once used to estimate fetal lung maturity and the risk of newborn respiratory distress. The test is now rarely used; a mature result alone does not establish the safety of early delivery.

Alternate Names:
L/S Ratio; Amniotic Fluid Lecithin-Sphingomyelin Ratio

Leech

A blood-feeding annelid used in selected reconstructive procedures to relieve venous congestion; leech bites can cause bleeding and infection.

Leech Therapy

Carefully controlled use of medicinal leeches to remove congested blood from selected tissue, especially after reconstructive surgery. Their saliva also prevents clotting. Bleeding, infection, anemia, and allergic reactions are possible, so clinical monitoring

is essential.

Leflunomide

Leflunomide is a disease-modifying antirheumatic drug that inhibits dihydroorotate dehydrogenase and lymphocyte proliferation; it treats rheumatoid or psoriatic arthritis but can cause hepatotoxicity, cytopenias, hypertension, and fetal harm.

Le Fort Fractures

A classification of traumatic midface fractures based on René Le Fort's fracture patterns. Le Fort I is a horizontal fracture through the upper jaw, Le Fort II is a pyramidal fracture through the midface, and Le Fort III separates the facial bones from the skull base.

Alternate Names:
Le Fort Midface Fractures; Maxillofacial Le Fort System

Left Anterior Descending Artery

A major branch of the left coronary artery that travels in the anterior interventricular groove and supplies the anterior left ventricle, much of the interventricular septum, and the apex. Its occlusion can cause extensive anterior myocardial infarction.

Left Anterior Descending Coronary Artery

A major heart artery supplying the front wall, septum, and much of the left ventricle; blockage can cause a serious heart attack.

Alternate Names:
LAD Artery

Left Anterior Fascicular Block

A cardiac intraventricular conduction defect caused by delay or block in the thin anterior fascicle of the left bundle branch, manifesting on electrocardiogram as marked left axis deviation (between -45 and -90 degrees), small Q waves in leads I and aVL, and small R waves in leads II, III, and aVF.

Alternate Names:
LAFB; Left Anterior Hemiblock

Left Atrial Appendage Occlusion

A procedure that seals a small pouch of the heart where blood clots often form in people with atrial fibrillation. A closure device is placed through a catheter, usually from a vein in the groin. It may reduce stroke risk when long-term blood-thinning medicine is unsuitable, but short-term medication and follow-up are still needed.

Alternate Names:
LAAO; Left Atrial Appendage Closure

Left Atrial Myxoma

A usually benign primary cardiac tumor, commonly arising from the interatrial septum in the left atrium. It may obstruct mitral inflow or cause embolic and constitutional symptoms such as fever, weight loss, or fatigue.

Left Atrium

The upper-left chamber of the heart. It receives oxygen-rich blood from the lungs and passes it through the mitral valve into the left ventricle.

Left Bundle Branch

Part of the heart's electrical wiring that carries signals through the left lower chamber and helps it contract. Damage or blockage can delay the heartbeat signal and appear on an electrocardiogram.

Left Bundle Branch Block

Delay or interruption of electrical signals through the left bundle branch. It changes the ECG pattern and may reflect heart disease, although some people have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
LBBB

Left Circumflex Coronary Artery

A heart artery curving around the left side and back, supplying parts of the left ventricle and sometimes the lower heart wall.

Alternate Names:
Circumflex Artery

Left Heart Catheterization

A procedure that passes a thin tube into the left side of the heart or nearby arteries to measure pressures, assess valves, or look for blocked coronary arteries.

Left Heart Ventricular Angiography

An imaging study that injects contrast into the left ventricle to assess ventricular contraction, wall motion, ejection fraction, and selected structural abnormalities.

Left Hypochondriac Region

The upper-left area of the abdomen, beneath the lower ribs. It overlies part of the stomach, spleen, pancreas, and colon; pain or swelling there may arise from digestive, splenic, or nearby chest disease.

Left Iliac Region

The lower-left area of the abdomen, overlying part of the large intestine and urinary tract. Pain there may occur with diverticular disease, bowel inflammation, urinary problems, or other pelvic conditions.

Left Lower Quadrant

The lower-left quarter of the abdomen, containing portions of the small and large intestines, the left ureter, and, in females, the left ovary and uterine tube.

Left Main Coronary Artery

The short vessel arising from the left aortic sinus and dividing principally into the left anterior descending and circumflex arteries. Significant left-main disease jeopardizes a large proportion of left-ventricular myocardium.

Left-Sided Superior Vena Cava

A birth-related variation in which a large vein on the left side of the chest drains blood through an unusual route to the heart. It usually causes no symptoms but matters when placing central lines or performing heart surgery.

Left Testicular Torsion

Acute rotation of the left testis on its spermatic cord, obstructing blood flow and causing ischemia. It is a urological emergency presenting with sudden severe left scrotal pain, nausea, vomiting, and a high-riding, horizontally oriented testis with absent cremasteric reflex.

Left Upper Quadrant

The upper-left quarter of the abdomen, containing portions of the stomach, spleen, pancreas, liver, and small and large intestines.

Left Ventricle

The lower-left chamber of the heart. It receives oxygen-rich blood from the left atrium and pumps it through the aortic valve into the aorta and throughout the body.

Left Ventricular Assist Device

A mechanical pump that helps the heart's main pumping chamber move blood around the body. It may support people with severe heart failure while they await a transplant or as long-term treatment. Risks include bleeding, infection, blood clots, and stroke.

Alternate Names:
LVAD; Left Ventricular Assist System

Left-Ventricular Assist Device

Alternate spelling; see *Left Ventricular Assist Device*.

Left Ventricular Hypertrophy

Thickening of the muscle wall of the heart's main pumping chamber. It is often caused by long-term high blood pressure or a narrowed aortic valve and can make the heart stiff, leading to breathlessness, rhythm problems, or heart failure.

Left Ventricular Non-Compaction

Alternate spelling; see *Left Ventricular Noncompaction*.

Left Ventricular Noncompaction

A finding in which the inner muscle of the heart's main pumping chamber has prominent ridges and

spaces. It may occur with heart muscle disease, but the appearance alone does not always mean a person has cardiomyopathy.

Alternate Names:
LVNC; Spongy Myocardium

Leg

The lower limb, often meaning the region between the knee and ankle, although it may also refer broadly to the entire lower extremity.

Leg CT Scan

A series of detailed X-ray pictures of the leg combined by a computer. It can show complex fractures, bone alignment, infection, tumors, blood-vessel problems, and selected soft-tissue injuries.

Leg Fracture

Alternate name; see *Broken Leg*.

Legg-Calve-Perthes Disease

A childhood hip disorder in which the blood supply to the top of the thighbone is temporarily reduced. The bone can weaken and change shape, causing a limp, hip or knee pain, stiffness, and limited movement.

Legg–Calvé–Perthes Disease

A childhood hip disorder in which reduced blood flow temporarily damages the rounded top of the thighbone. It can cause a limp, hip or knee pain, stiffness, and later deformity as the bone heals.

Legionella

Legionella is a group of water-associated bacteria that can cause Legionnaires' disease, a severe pneumonia, or Pontiac fever, a milder illness.

Legionella Longbeachae

Legionella longbeachae is a Legionella species associated particularly with exposure to contaminated potting mix and capable of causing pneumonia.

Legionella Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by Legionella bacteria, usually after inhaling contaminated water droplets. It can cause high fever, cough, breathlessness, diarrhea, confusion, and low oxygen.

Legionella Pneumophila

A bacterium found in water systems that can cause severe pneumonia after a person inhales contaminated water droplets. It may also cause a milder fever illness; older age, smoking, and weakened immunity increase risk.

Legionellosis

An infection caused by Legionella bacteria, ranging from a mild flu-like illness to Legionnaires' disease with pneumonia.

Legionnaire Disease And Pontiac Fever

Alternate name; see *Legionellosis*.

Legionnaires Disease

A severe, potentially life-threatening type of pneumonia caused by inhaling tiny water droplets contaminated with extitLegionella bacteria. These bacteria thrive in warm, human-made water systems such as commercial building air-conditioning cooling towers, hot tubs, large plumbing systems, and decorative fountains. Symptoms typically begin with high fever, chills, cough, muscle aches, and headache, often accompanied by digestive symptoms like nausea, diarrhea, and confusion.

Legionnaires' Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Legionnaires Disease*.

Leg Lengthening And Shortening

Operations that gradually increase or decrease the length of a leg bone to correct a major difference between the legs or a deformity. Recovery is prolonged and may involve an external or internal support device and rehabilitation.

Leg MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the leg using a magnetic field and radio waves to evaluate muscles, tendons, ligaments, nerves, marrow, joints, and soft-

tissue masses.

Leg Or Foot Amputation

Surgical removal of part or all of a leg or foot, usually because of severe injury, infection, poor blood flow, or cancer. Rehabilitation supports mobility afterward.

Leg Pain

Pain in part of a lower limb, commonly the thigh, knee, calf, or foot. Causes include muscle or tendon injury, joint disease, nerve irritation, reduced blood flow, infection, or a blood clot.

Leg Pain With Cramping

Painful tightening or spasms in a leg muscle; causes include exertion, dehydration, medicines, nerve or muscle disorders, and reduced arterial blood flow causing intermittent claudication.

Leg Swelling

Enlargement or puffiness of one or both legs caused by fluid retention, venous disease, injury, infection, inflammation, or a blood clot.

Leg Ulcer

An open sore on the lower leg that heals slowly or not at all. Causes include poor blood flow in the veins or arteries, diabetes-related nerve damage, pressure, and inflammation. Venous ulcers often occur near the ankle and may come with leg swelling or varicose veins; treatment depends on the cause.

Leg Ulceration

Alternate name; see *Leg Ulcer*.

Leigh Disease

A progressive mitochondrial disorder of early life characterized by symmetric lesions of the brainstem and basal ganglia, developmental regression, movement abnormalities, and lactic acidosis.

Leigh's Syndrome

A rare progressive neurologic disorder, usually beginning in infancy or childhood, caused by problems with cellular energy production. It can damage the brainstem and cause developmental regression, movement problems, seizures, or breathing difficulties.

Leigh Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder of cellular energy production, usually beginning in infancy or childhood. It can damage the brainstem and deep brain areas, causing loss of developmental skills, movement problems, seizures, and breathing difficulties.

Alternate Names:
Subacute Necrotizing Encephalomyelopathy; Mitochondrial Leigh Disease

Leiomyoma

A usually noncancerous tumor made of smooth muscle. It most often develops in the uterus, where it is called a fibroid, but it can also occur in the skin, digestive tract, or other organs.

Leiomyomatosis

Leiomyomatosis is development of multiple benign smooth-muscle tumors or proliferations, which may affect the uterus, skin, lungs, or other sites.

Leiomyomatosis Peritonealis Disseminata

A rare benign condition with multiple smooth-muscle nodules scattered over the peritoneum, often associated with pregnancy or hormonal stimulation and sometimes mimicking peritoneal carcinomatosis.

Leiomyosarcoma

A malignant tumor of smooth muscle, most often arising in the uterus, retroperitoneum, or gastrointestinal tract.

Leiomyosarcoma Of The Vulva

A rare malignant smooth-muscle tumor of the vulva, usually presenting as a solitary enlarging mass. Histologic atypia, mitotic activity, necrosis, and invasion help determine malignant behavior.

Leishmania

A group of single-celled parasites transmitted mainly by infected sandflies. Different species cause skin, mucosal, or visceral leishmaniasis, ranging from localized ulcers to life-threatening illness.

Leishmania Donovani

A parasite spread by infected sandflies that causes visceral leishmaniasis. It can infect organs such as the spleen, liver, and bone marrow, causing prolonged fever, weight loss, enlarged organs, and reduced blood-cell counts.

Leishmania Infection

A parasitic infection caused by *Leishmania* protozoa and transmitted by infected sandflies; it can cause cutaneous, mucocutaneous, or visceral leishmaniasis.

Leishmania Major

A parasite commonly causing cutaneous leishmaniasis in parts of Africa, Asia, and the Middle East. Sandfly transmission produces one or more skin ulcers that may heal slowly and leave scars.

Leishmania Mexicana

A parasite that causes mainly cutaneous leishmaniasis in the Americas. Infection after a sandfly bite may produce a persistent skin nodule or ulcer and, less commonly, involve mucous membranes.

Leishmaniasis

An infection caused by protozoa of the genus *Leishmania*, usually transmitted by infected sandflies. Cutaneous, mucocutaneous, and visceral forms cause skin lesions, destructive disease of mucous membranes, or systemic illness involving organs such as the liver, spleen, and bone marrow.

Leishmania Tropica

A sandfly-transmitted parasite that commonly causes localized cutaneous leishmaniasis. It produces chronic skin sores that may heal over months and leave permanent scars.

Lemaitre's Sign

Pain or discomfort felt in the urethra or penis during a rectal examination. It has traditionally been associated with inflammation near the prostate or back part of the urinary passage but is not specific for one diagnosis.

Lemierre Syndrome

A rare but serious complication of a throat or mouth infection. The infection can spread to a large vein in the neck, form an infected blood clot, and spread to the lungs or other parts of the body.

Lenalidomide

Lenalidomide is an immunomodulatory anticancer drug used for multiple myeloma and selected myelodysplastic or lymphoma disorders; myelosuppression, thrombosis, infection, and severe teratogenicity are important risks.

Lenegre Disease

An idiopathic, sclerodegenerative process characterized by slowly progressive fibrocalcific degeneration and loss of conduction fibers within the His-Purkinje system, leading to bundle branch blocks, bifascicular block, and spontaneous complete atrioventricular block in middle-aged individuals.

Alternate Names:
Primary Conduction System Sclerosis

Lengthening Of Limb

A surgical or orthopedic process that gradually increases the length of a bone, often using controlled distraction after osteotomy.

Length-Time Bias

The tendency of screening to preferentially detect slower-growing or less aggressive disease because it remains detectable for a longer preclinical period. It can exaggerate the apparent benefit of screening.

Lennox-Gastaut Syndrome

A severe childhood-onset developmental and epileptic encephalopathy with multiple seizure types, characteristic slow spike-and-wave EEG patterns, cog-

nitive impairment, and often treatment-resistant seizures.

Lenograstim

A recombinant granulocyte colony-stimulating factor that increases neutrophil production and is used to prevent or treat some forms of neutropenia.

Lens

A clear, flexible structure behind the iris and pupil that bends light onto the retina. Muscles change its shape for near or distant focus; clouding causes cataract, while displacement can blur vision or raise eye pressure.

Lens Coloboma

A lens coloboma is a congenital segmental defect or notch in the eye lens caused by incomplete development.

Lens Disease

A disorder of the eye lens, including cataract, dislocation, inflammation-related opacity, or developmental abnormality, that may impair focusing or vision.

Lens Dislocation

Displacement of the crystalline lens from its normal position because of trauma, zonular weakness, surgery, or connective-tissue disease; it can cause blurred vision, glaucoma, or inflammation.

Lensometer

An instrument measuring the prescription, power, and optical alignment of eyeglass lenses. It helps verify new glasses, assess existing lenses, and check whether corrective strength matches the prescribed values.

Alternate Names:
Lensmeter; Focimeter

Lens Prescription

Written instructions specifying the lens power, correction, and other features needed for eyeglasses or contact lenses in each eye.

Lens Subluxation

Partial displacement of the crystalline lens while some zonular attachments remain, potentially causing blurred or fluctuating vision, refractive change, or glaucoma.

Lentiform Nucleus

A group of deep brain structures involved in controlling movement. It includes the putamen and globus pallidus and works with other brain regions to help start and regulate actions.

Lentigines

Alternate plural name; see *Lentigo*.

Lentigo

A lentigo is a sharply defined flat brown skin spot caused by increased melanocytes or pigment and may be benign or, rarely, atypical.

Lentigo Maligna

A melanoma in situ that occurs on chronically sun-damaged skin, most commonly on the face of elderly individuals. It presents as a large, irregularly pigmented, slow-growing macule with variegated shades of brown and black. The radial growth phase may persist for years before invasion occurs.

Lentigo Maligna Melanoma

An invasive melanoma arising in a lentigo maligna on chronically sun-damaged skin, usually of the head or neck; it presents as an enlarging irregular pigmented patch or plaque.

LEOPARD Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder that can cause many dark skin spots, abnormal heart rhythms, widely spaced eyes, narrowing of the pulmonary valve, genital differences, slow growth, and hearing loss. The combination and severity vary between people.

Leopold Maneuvers

A set of gentle abdominal examinations used to estimate the baby's position and which part is presenting before birth. The findings help guide care

but may be limited by body size, fluid level, or the baby's movement and are confirmed with other assessment when needed.

Lepidoptera

The insect order containing butterflies and moths; contact with some caterpillars can cause skin, eye, or systemic reactions.

Lepirudin

Lepirudin is a direct thrombin inhibitor formerly used as an anticoagulant in heparin-induced thrombocytopenia; bleeding and kidney clearance are important considerations.

Lepromatous Leprosy

A form of leprosy with a high number of bacteria and usually widespread skin involvement. It can cause numerous poorly defined patches, nodules, or diffuse thickening, including on the face, and may affect the nose, eyes, and peripheral nerves. Sensation may be preserved early, but untreated nerve damage can lead to numbness, weakness, and disability.

Lepromin Skin Test

A skin test using harmless material from the leprosy bacterium to show how strongly the immune system reacts. It may help classify the type of leprosy but cannot by itself diagnose active infection.

Leprosy

A chronic infection caused by *Mycobacterium leprae* or *M. lepromatosis*, mainly affecting the skin, peripheral nerves, eyes, and upper respiratory mucosa. It can cause pale or reddish skin patches with reduced sensation, thickened nerves, and muscle weakness.

Alternate Names:
Hansen Disease; Hansen's Disease

Leptin

A hormone produced mainly by adipose tissue that signals stored-energy status to the brain and influences appetite and energy balance.

Leptin Receptor

A cell-surface protein that receives signals from leptin, a hormone made mainly by fat tissue. It helps the brain regulate appetite, energy use, growth, and reproductive function in response to stored body energy.

Leptomeningeal

Relating to the pia mater and arachnoid mater, the two thin inner layers covering the brain and spinal cord; cancer or infection can spread in these layers.

Leptomeningeal Metastases

Spread of cancer cells to the pia and arachnoid membranes or cerebrospinal fluid. It may cause headache, nausea, cranial-nerve findings, radicular pain, weakness, sensory change, or bladder dysfunction; MRI and cerebrospinal-fluid testing support diagnosis.

Leptomeningeal Metastasis

Spread of cancer to the thin membranes and fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord. It can cause headache, vomiting, weakness, confusion, seizures, or changes in vision and is treated according to the cancer type and extent.

Leptomeningeal Sarcoma

Leptomeningeal sarcoma is a rare malignant tumor involving the membranes and fluid spaces around the brain or spinal cord.

Leptomeninges

The arachnoid mater and pia mater, the two delicate inner membranes covering the brain and spinal cord.

Leptomeningitis

Inflammation or infection of the leptomeninges, the arachnoid and pia mater covering the brain and spinal cord.

Leptospira

A genus of spiral-shaped bacteria that includes the causes of leptospirosis, usually acquired through water or soil contaminated with infected animal

urine.

Leptospirosis

A zoonotic infection caused by pathogenic spiral-shaped *Leptospira* bacteria. It is usually acquired through contact with infected animal urine or contaminated water, soil, or food; bacteria enter through broken skin or mucous membranes. Illness ranges from asymptomatic infection to fever, headache, muscle pain, and conjunctival redness. Severe disease, classically called Weil disease, can cause jaundice, kidney or liver failure, bleeding, and lung injury.

Alternate Names:
Leptospira Infection; Mud Fever; Seven-Day Fever

Leriche Syndrome

Aortoiliac occlusive disease causing reduced blood flow to the pelvis and lower limbs. The classic presentation includes buttock or thigh claudication, diminished femoral pulses, and erectile dysfunction, although symptoms vary with the extent of collateral circulation.

Leri-Weill Dyschondrosteosis

A rare autosomal dominant pseudoautosomal skeletal dysplasia caused by haploinsufficiency of the short stature homeobox (SHOX) gene on the X and Y chromosomes, characterized by disproportionate mesomelic short stature, shortened forearms and lower legs, and bilateral Madelung wrist deformity.

Alternate Names:
Leri-Weill Syndrome; SHOX Deficiency Mesomelic Dysplasia

Lesch-Nyhan Syndrome

An inherited disorder of purine metabolism caused by severe HPRT enzyme deficiency, leading to high uric acid, neurologic problems, and characteristic self-injurious behavior.

Lesion

Any localized abnormal change in tissue caused by disease, injury, inflammation, infection, or a tumor. A lesion may be visible, felt, or found only on imaging or microscopic examination.

Lesion Identification

The process of locating and describing an abnormal area in the body using examination, imaging, endoscopy, laboratory tests, or tissue sampling.

Lesser Curvature

The shorter, inward curve along the upper and inner edge of the stomach. It is attached to a fold of tissue leading to the liver and contains blood vessels that supply the stomach.

Lesser Omentum

A fold of tissue that connects the liver to the lesser curvature of the stomach and the first part of the small intestine. It contains blood vessels, ducts, nerves, and lymph vessels.

Lesser Peritoneal Cavity

The peritoneal recess behind the stomach and lesser omentum, also called the lesser sac or omental bursa. It communicates with the greater peritoneal cavity through the epiploic foramen.

Alternate Names:
Lesser Sac; Omental Bursa

Lesser Toe Deformities

Deformities in which one or more toes bend abnormally at the middle or end joints. They may cause pain, rubbing, corns, calluses, or difficulty wearing shoes.

Lesser Trochanter

A small bony projection on the inner upper thighbone where the iliopsoas muscle attaches. It helps bend the hip; injury may occur from a sudden muscle pull in adolescents or, in adults, from weakened bone.

Let-Down Reflex

Release of breast milk when oxytocin makes the small muscles around milk-producing glands contract. Suckling, breast stimulation, or seeing or hearing a baby can trigger it, although stress may delay it.

Lethal

Able to cause death. In medicine, the word may describe a disease, injury, dose of a substance, or genetic change that prevents survival.

Lethal-Means Counseling

A preventive intervention that reduces access to firearms, medications, toxic substances, or other methods of self-harm during periods of elevated risk. It is conducted collaboratively and is an important component of suicide prevention.

Lethal Triad

A dangerous combination of low body temperature, excess acid in the blood, and poor blood clotting. It can develop after severe injury or major bleeding, and each problem can worsen the others.

Lethargy

Lethargy is reduced energy, alertness, or responsiveness; it may result from sleep loss, infection, metabolic disease, medicines, depression, or neurologic illness. Sudden marked lethargy can occur with serious illness.

Letrozole

Letrozole is an aromatase inhibitor that lowers oestrogen production and is used mainly for hormone-receptor-positive breast cancer and ovulation induction; hot flushes, arthralgia, bone loss, and fetal harm are important considerations.

Letterer-Siwe Disease

An acute, disseminated, aggressive multisystem form of Langerhans cell histiocytosis occurring in infants and toddlers under 2 years of age, characterized by cutaneous seborrheic and purpuric eruptions, osteolytic bone lesions, hepatosplenomegaly, lymphadenopathy, and pancytopenia.

Alternate Names:
Acute Disseminated LCH; Multisystem Langerhans Histiocytosis

Leucocyte

Another spelling of leukocyte, meaning a white blood cell. Leukocytes help defend against infection and other threats; major groups include neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils.

Leucocytosis

A higher-than-usual number of white blood cells in the blood. It may occur with infection, inflammation, physical stress, medicines, smoking, or blood and bone-marrow disorders, so the type of cell and the person's symptoms help find the cause.

Leucoderma

Loss or marked reduction of skin pigmentation, often used as a descriptive term for depigmented patches.

Leucomalacia

Softening or loss of tissue after injury, poor blood flow, infection, or inflammation. In newborns, the term often refers to damage of the brain's white matter near the fluid spaces, which may affect movement or development.

Leucopenia

A lower-than-usual number of white blood cells. It may result from medicines, infections, immune disorders, nutritional deficiency, or bone-marrow disease and can increase the risk of infection, especially when neutrophils are low.

Leucoplakia

A persistent white patch on a moist body lining, often inside the mouth, that cannot be wiped away. It may result from irritation and sometimes contains changes that can precede cancer.

Leucopoiesis

The production and maturation of white blood cells, mainly in the bone marrow. It is regulated by growth factors and increases or changes during infection, inflammation, and some blood disorders.

Leucovorin

Leucovorin is a folate medicine used to reduce the toxicity of methotrexate, enhance some chemotherapy regimens, and treat certain folate-related prob-

lems.

Leucovorin Calcium

Leucovorin calcium is the calcium salt of leucovorin, used as rescue therapy after methotrexate and in selected colorectal-cancer treatments.

Leukaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Leukemia*.

Leukapheresis

A blood-filtering procedure that removes excess white blood cells and returns the remaining blood. It may rapidly reduce very high counts causing symptoms in leukemia, but it is temporary and does not replace treatment of the underlying disease.

Leukemia

A group of blood cancers that originate in the bone marrow, the soft sponge-like tissue inside bones where blood cells are made. Leukemia causes the bone marrow to produce large numbers of abnormal, immature white blood cells that do not function properly and crowd out healthy red blood cells, platelets, and infection-fighting white blood cells. This leads to symptoms such as fatigue and pale skin (from anemia), frequent infections, easy bruising or bleeding, bone pain, and swollen lymph nodes.

Leukemia Cutis

A condition in which leukemia cells collect in the skin, causing firm red, purple, or brown bumps, nodules, or patches. It often accompanies acute myeloid leukemia and reflects the underlying blood cancer.

Leukemia Genetics

Changes in genes or chromosomes in leukemia cells help identify the leukemia type, estimate its likely course, and choose treatment. The meaning of each change depends on the person's specific leukemia.

Leukemic Infiltration Of The Gingiva

Swelling of the gums caused by leukemia cells collecting in gum tissue. The gums may become red, soft, enlarged, and prone to bleeding, especially in some acute myeloid leukemias.

Leukemoid Reaction

A marked reactive increase in the white-cell count, usually with prominent neutrophilia and immature granulocytes, caused by severe infection, inflammation, malignancy, or tissue injury. It resembles leukemia but is not a clonal hematologic malignancy.

Leukoaraiosis

White-matter changes seen on brain scans, often related to aging and long-term small-vessel disease such as high blood pressure. Extensive changes may be associated with slower thinking, walking problems, or stroke risk.

Leukocoria

A white or pale reflection appearing in the pupil instead of the normal red reflection. It may result from cataract, retinal disease, infection, or a tumor such as retinoblastoma and is especially important in infants and children.

Leukocyte

A medical term for a white blood cell, the cellular defense units of the immune system that protect the body against infectious diseases, foreign substances, and abnormal cells. Formed in the bone marrow, leukocytes include several specialized types: neutrophils and macrophages that engulf bacteria, lymphocytes that produce antibodies and kill infected cells, and eosinophils and basophils that respond to parasites and allergic reactions.

Leukocyte Adhesion Deficiency

A rare inherited immune disorder in which white blood cells cannot attach to blood-vessel walls and reach infected tissue normally. It can cause delayed umbilical-cord separation, repeated skin infections with little pus, poor wound healing, gum disease, and dangerously severe infection in infants.

Leukocyte Alkaline Phosphatase

A measure of an enzyme in certain white blood cells. It was formerly used to help distinguish a reactive

response to infection from chronic myeloid leukemia, but newer genetic and blood tests are usually more informative.

Leukocyte Disorder

A disorder involving the number, function, or development of white blood cells, including leukopenia, leukocytosis, immune deficiency, and malignant leukocyte proliferation.

Leukocyte Esterase Urine Test

A urine dipstick test detecting leukocyte esterase released by white blood cells; a positive result supports pyuria but does not by itself diagnose urinary tract infection.

Leukocytes

Plural form; see *Leukocyte*.

Leukocyte Transfusion

Transfusion of donated white blood cells in rare, carefully selected situations involving life-threatening infection and severe inability to produce neutrophils. Benefits are uncertain and risks include fever, lung injury, immune reactions, and infection transmission.

Leukocytoclastic Vasculitis

A pattern of inflammation in small blood vessels, usually identified by examining a skin biopsy. It commonly causes raised purple or red spots that can be felt, especially on the legs. Medicines, infections, and immune diseases may trigger it; evaluation checks whether inflammation is limited to the skin or also affects internal organs.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Small-Vessel Vasculitis

Leukocytosis

A higher-than-usual number of white blood cells. It may occur with infection, inflammation, stress, smoking, medicines, or blood and bone-marrow disorders; the specific cell type and symptoms help identify the cause.

Leukocytosis in Pregnancy

A mild rise in white blood cells can be normal during pregnancy, labor, or stress. Marked or persistent elevation with fever, pain, urinary or respiratory symptoms, or abnormal differential counts may indicate infection, inflammation, medication effect, or another disorder.

Leukocyturia

Alternate name; see *Pyuria*.

Leukoderma

Loss of skin pigment producing sharply defined pale or white patches, usually because melanocytes have been destroyed or have stopped functioning.

Alternate Names:
Achromoderma

Leukodystrophy

A group of inherited disorders that damage myelin, the protective covering around nerves in the brain and spinal cord. They can cause progressive problems with movement, thinking, vision, hearing, or other nervous-system functions.

Leukoencephalopathy

Leukoencephalopathy is disease of the brain's white matter caused by inherited, infectious, toxic, vascular, metabolic, inflammatory, or other processes.

Leukonychia

White spots, lines, or large white areas on one or more nails. Minor nail injury is a common cause; some forms are inherited or linked to infection, medicines, or illness. The pattern and whether it moves as the nail grows can help identify the cause.

Leukonychia Striata

White bands or streaks in the nail plate that may run transversely or longitudinally. They can result from inherited traits, changes in the nail matrix, trauma, skin disease, or some medicines; significance depends on the pattern and cause.

Leukonychia Totalis

Uniform white discoloration involving most or all of one or more nail plates. It is often inherited but can occasionally be associated with illness or medication; persistent changes affecting many nails can occur with other conditions.

Leukopenia

A lower-than-normal number of white blood cells in the blood. It often involves a low neutrophil count, but other types of white blood cells may also be low. Infection risk depends on which cells are low and by how much.

Leukoplakia

A lasting white patch in the mouth that cannot be wiped off and is not explained by another condition. A tissue sample may show normal cells, precancerous changes, or cancer.

Leukopoiesis

The process by which the bone marrow makes and develops white blood cells. Production increases or changes during infection, inflammation, immune disorders, and some blood diseases.

Leukorrhea

Whitish vaginal discharge that may be normal, especially during hormonal changes, or may result from infection or inflammation. Foul odor, itching, pain, bleeding, or a new change may suggest an underlying condition.

Leukostasis

A medical emergency in which very high numbers of abnormal leukocytes impair microvascular blood flow, potentially causing respiratory distress, neurologic symptoms, organ ischemia, or hemorrhage.

Leukotriene

A group of inflammatory chemical messengers produced by white blood cells during allergic reactions and immune responses. When released in the airways, leukotrienes cause the smooth muscles around breathing tubes to tighten and constrict, stimulate excessive mucus production, and trigger airway swelling, playing a central role in asthma attacks, hay fever, and allergic reactions.

Leukotriene Blockers

Medicines that block leukotriene receptors, reducing airway tightening and inflammation. They can help prevent asthma or allergy symptoms but do not treat a sudden asthma attack.

Alternate Names:
Leukotriene Receptor Antagonists

Leukotriene Modifiers

Medicines that reduce the production or effects of leukotrienes, inflammatory chemicals that narrow airways and cause allergy symptoms. They help prevent some asthma or allergy problems but do not usually relieve a sudden asthma attack.

Leukotriene Receptor

A cell-surface protein activated by leukotrienes, inflammatory chemicals that can narrow airways, increase mucus, and promote swelling. Blocking these receptors can help prevent selected asthma and allergy symptoms.

Leukotrienes

Plural form; see *Leukotriene*.

Leuprolide

Leuprolide is a gonadotropin-releasing hormone agonist used to suppress sex-hormone production in conditions such as prostate cancer, endometriosis, and fibroids.

Leuprolide Acetate

Leuprolide acetate is the salt form of leuprolide, used to suppress ovarian or testicular hormone production for selected medical conditions.

Levalbuterol

An inhaled short-acting bronchodilator that stimulates beta-2 receptors and relaxes airway muscle. It relieves wheezing and shortness of breath but may cause tremor, nervousness, headache, or a fast heartbeat.

Levamisole

Levamisole is an antiparasitic and immune-modulating drug used selectively; serious low white-cell counts and vasculitic reactions can occur.

Levator Ani

A group of pelvic-floor muscles that supports the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs and helps control urination and bowel movements. Weakness or injury may contribute to pelvic organ prolapse or incontinence.

Levator Ani Muscle

A broad, symmetrical muscular sheet forming the major constituent of the pelvic diaphragm, composed of the puborectalis, pubococcygeus, and iliococcygeus muscles, which supports the pelvic viscera and maintains urinary and fecal continence.

Levator Ani Syndrome

A chronic functional anorectal pain disorder characterized by episodic or continuous dull aching, fullness, or pressure sensation in the rectum and perineum that is aggravated by prolonged sitting, associated with tenderness and spasm of the levator ani and puborectalis muscle on digital rectal palpation.

Alternate Names:
Levator Spasm Syndrome

Lev Disease

An age-related degenerative disorder of the cardiac conduction system involving fibrosis and calcification of the fibrous cardiac skeleton and adjacent conduction tissue. It can cause atrioventricular block or bundle-branch block. It is distinguished from Lenègre disease, which classically involves fibrosis predominantly of the His-Purkinje conduction fibres.

Alternate Names:
Idiopathic Conduction System Sclerosis

Levetiracetam

Levetiracetam is a broad-spectrum antiseizure medicine that binds synaptic vesicle protein SV2A; it treats focal and generalized seizures and may cause somnolence, dizziness, or behavioral and mood changes.

Levine Sign

A gesture in which a person places a clenched fist over the chest while describing chest pain. It may occur with heart-related pain but is not specific enough to diagnose angina or a heart attack.

Alternate Names:
Levine's Sign; Clenched Fist Chest Pain Sign

Levobunolol

Levobunolol is a beta-blocker eye drop used to lower pressure inside the eye in glaucoma or ocular hypertension.

Levocardia

Levocardia is a normal left-sided position of the heart; it may occur with normal organ arrangement or with other congenital laterality abnormalities.

Levocarnitine

Levocarnitine is the biologically active form of carnitine used to treat selected carnitine deficiencies and help transport fatty acids into mitochondria.

Levodopa

Levodopa is a dopamine precursor that crosses the blood–brain barrier and is converted to dopamine, usually with carbidopa or benserazide, to treat Parkinson disease; dyskinesias, hallucinations, nausea, and motor fluctuations can develop.

Levofloxacin

Levofloxacin is a fluoroquinolone antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; tendon injury, peripheral neuropathy, QT prolongation, dysglycaemia, and central-nervous-system effects are important class risks.

Levoleucovorin

Levoleucovorin is the active isomer of leucovorin, used as methotrexate rescue and with selected chemotherapy regimens.

Levoleucovorin Calcium

Levoleucovorin calcium is the calcium salt of levoleucovorin, used to reduce methotrexate toxicity and support selected cancer treatments.

Levomepromazine

A phenothiazine medicine with antipsychotic, sedative, antiemetic, and analgesic properties, used in selected palliative-care and psychiatric settings.

Levonorgestrel

A progestin hormone used in birth-control pills, hormonal intrauterine devices, and emergency contraception to prevent or delay ovulation and alter cervical mucus.

Levorphanol

Levorphanol is a potent opioid analgesic that can relieve severe pain but also cause sedation, dependence, and respiratory depression.

Levothyroxine

A synthetic form of thyroxine (T4) used as thyroid hormone replacement in hypothyroidism and in selected other thyroid conditions; dose is individualized and monitored with laboratory tests.

Levothyroxine Sodium

A manufactured form of thyroid hormone used to replace hormone missing in hypothyroidism. The dose is adjusted using blood tests, and it is usually taken consistently on an empty stomach.

Alternate Names:
Levothyroxine

Levulose

An older name for fructose, a simple sugar found in fruit, honey, and many sweeteners.

Lewy Bodies

Abnormal deposits of the protein alpha-synuclein inside nerve cells. They are seen in Parkinson disease and dementia with Lewy bodies and are associated with movement, thinking, sleep, and visual-perception problems.

Lewy Body

A Lewy body is an abnormal neuronal inclusion containing alpha-synuclein, characteristic of Parkinson disease and Lewy-body dementia.

Lewy Body Dementia

A progressive brain disorder linked to clumps of protein called Lewy bodies in nerve cells. It can cause changes in attention and thinking, seeing things that are not there, movement problems like those in Parkinson disease, and acting out dreams during sleep. In dementia with Lewy bodies, thinking problems begin before or within about a year of movement problems; if they begin later in established Parkinson disease, the term Parkinson disease dementia is used. Some people with Lewy body dementia are very sensitive to certain antipsychotic medicines.

Alternate Names:
DLB; Dementia with Lewy Bodies

Lewy Body Disease

A progressive brain disorder caused by abnormal protein deposits in nerve cells. It may cause changing attention, visual hallucinations, movement problems, stiffness, sleep-related behaviors, and gradual difficulty with thinking and daily activities.

Leydig Cell

A specialized steroidogenic polyhedral endocrine cell situated within the interstitial connective tissue stroma between the seminiferous tubules of the testis (interstitial cell of Leydig). Characterized ultrastructurally by abundant smooth endoplasmic reticulum, lipid droplets, mitochondria with tubulovesicular cristae, and prominent cytoplasmic proteinaceous crystals of Reinke. Under the primary trophic stimulation of pituitary luteinizing hormone (LH)—which binds to G-protein-coupled LH receptors to stimulate cyclic AMP production and StAR (steroidogenic acute regulatory) protein-mediated cholesterol transport into mitochondria—Leydig cells synthesize and secrete the vast majority ($> 95\%$) of systemic testosterone in biological males. Testosterone is essential for in utero virilization of Wolffian duct structures, testicular descent, pubertal maturation

of secondary sexual characteristics, maintenance of libido, bone density, muscle mass, and paracrine support of Sertoli cells for spermatogenesis. Leydig cell dysfunction or destruction results in primary hypogonadism with compensatory hypergonadotropism.

Leydig Cells

Plural form; see *Leydig Cell*.

Leydig Cell Testicular Tumor

A usually rare sex-cord stromal tumor arising from testosterone-producing Leydig cells in the testis; it may cause a testicular mass or hormone-related signs.

Leydig Cell Tumor

A testicular sex cord-stromal tumor that secretes testosterone or estrogen, causing precocious puberty or gynecomastia; most are benign and treated by orchidectomy.

LGE

Alternate name; see *Late Gadolinium Enhancement*.

LGMD

Abbreviation for limb-girdle muscular dystrophy; see *Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophies*.

LGS

Abbreviation for Lennox-Gastaut syndrome; see *Lennox-Gastaut Syndrome*.

LH

Luteinising hormone, a hormone released by the pituitary gland. In people with ovaries it helps trigger ovulation and supports hormone production; in people with testes it stimulates testosterone production. Blood tests can help assess reproductive or pituitary problems.

Alternate Names:
Luteinizing Hormone

Lhermitte-Duclos Disease

A rare, usually slow-growing abnormal area in the cerebellum, the part of the brain that helps control balance and movement. It may cause headache, dizziness, poor coordination, or seizures and can be associated with PTEN-related conditions, but it is not by itself proof of one diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Dysplastic Gangliocytoma of the Cerebellum; Cerebellar Hamartoma

Lhermitte Sign

A sudden electric shock-like sensation that travels down the neck and back into the arms or legs when bending the head forward, often seen in multiple sclerosis.

Lhermitte's Sign

Alternate spelling; see *Lhermitte Sign*.

LH Response To GnRH Blood Test

A hormone test that measures luteinizing hormone before and after a medicine that stimulates its release. It helps assess delayed or early puberty and problems involving the brain, pituitary gland, ovaries, or testes.

Libido

A person's sexual desire or interest. It can change with age, relationships, mood, stress, sleep, illness, pregnancy, menopause, hormone levels, and medicines; a change is important mainly when it causes distress or affects a person's wellbeing.

Libido And Sexual Performance

Sexual desire and sexual function can be influenced by hormones, blood flow, nerves, medicines, illness, mood, stress, sleep, and relationships. A persistent or distressing change deserves an assessment for treatable causes.

Libman-Sacks Endocarditis

A sterile, nonbacterial endocardial valvulopathy with verrucous vegetations, most strongly associated with systemic lupus erythematosus and antiphospholipid syndrome. It usually affects the mitral or aortic valve and may cause regurgitation or systemic emboli; infective endocarditis must be excluded when vegetations or fever are present.

Alternate Names:
Marantic Endocarditis; Verrucous Endocarditis; Nonbacterial Verrucous Endocarditis

Lice

Small insects that live on hair or clothing and feed on blood. Head, body, and pubic lice cause itching and may leave eggs attached to hair. They spread mainly through close contact and are not a sign of poor hygiene.

Lice Infestation

Alternate term; see *Lice*.

Lice Infestations

Alternate plural form; see *Lice*.

Licensed Clinical Social Worker

A social worker licensed to provide clinical assessment and psychotherapy or other mental-health services within the scope of local law and training.

Lichen

A descriptive term for a firm, flat-topped, raised skin lesion or for a skin pattern resembling lichen planus. It describes appearance rather than a single disease or cause.

Lichen Amyloidosis

A localized cutaneous amyloidosis causing intensely itchy, rough, hyperkeratotic papules, commonly on the shins or upper back. The deposited amyloid usually derives from damaged keratinocytes and remains confined to the skin.

Lichen Annularis

Alternate name for granuloma annulare, a benign inflammatory ring-shaped skin eruption; see *Granuloma Annulare*.

Lichenification

Thick, leathery skin with more visible skin lines caused by repeated scratching or rubbing. It often develops in long-lasting eczema, allergies, or other itchy skin conditions.

Lichenified

Lichenified skin is thickened and leathery from chronic rubbing or scratching, commonly occurring in longstanding eczema or itch disorders.

Lichen Myxedematosus

A group of rare disorders in which mucin accumulates in the skin, producing firm papules, plaques, or diffuse thickening. The generalized form may be associated with monoclonal gammopathy and internal-organ disease, whereas localized forms may remain confined to the skin.

Lichen Nitidus

A benign inflammatory skin disorder causing numerous tiny, shiny, flat-topped, skin-colored or pink papules, commonly on the trunk, arms, genital area, or hands. It is often asymptomatic and may resolve spontaneously, although itch or extensive disease may need treatment.

Lichenoid Drug Eruption

A lichenoid inflammatory skin reaction caused by a medicine, often resembling lichen planus but with a broader distribution or different clinical and histologic features; improvement may follow withdrawal of the culprit drug.

Lichen Planopilaris

A lymphocytic inflammatory scalp disorder that attacks hair follicles and can cause scarring alopecia, perifollicular scale, redness, and permanent hair loss.

Lichen Planus

A noncontagious inflammatory disorder, generally thought to be immune-mediated, that can affect the skin, mouth, genitals, nails, or scalp. Skin lesions are often itchy, flat-topped, shiny papules that may appear purple, red-brown, or gray; oral disease can form a lacy white pattern or painful erosions.

Alternate Names:
Lichen Ruber Planus

Lichen Planus Sclerosus Atrophicus

Historical or combined name; see *Lichen Sclerosus*.

Lichen Psoriasis

A descriptive or overlapping term for psoriasis with lichenified, thickened, scaly plaques; similar appearances occur in lichen planus and chronic eczema.

Lichen Ruber Planus

Alternate name; see *Lichen Planus*.

Lichen Sclerosus

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder that most often affects genital or perianal skin, producing pale, thin, fragile plaques that may itch, bruise, or scar. It can also occur elsewhere on the body; longstanding genital disease is associated with an increased risk of squamous-cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
White Spot Disease

Lichen Simplex Chronicus

One or more thickened, leathery skin plaques produced by repeated scratching or rubbing in an itch-scratch cycle. It commonly affects the neck, scalp, ankles, lower legs, or genital skin and may develop over an underlying itchy skin or nerve condition.

Lichen Spinulosus

A benign follicular eruption of grouped, rough, spiny papules, often forming round or oval plaques on the trunk, buttocks, or limbs. It commonly begins in childhood or adolescence and may fade spontaneously.

Lichen Striatus

A usually harmless skin condition causing small, flat, pink, brown, or pale bumps in a line along a limb. It often affects children and usually clears without treatment.

Lichen Urticatus

Alternate name for papular urticaria, an itchy hypersensitivity reaction to insect bites; see *Papular Urticaria*.

Licorice Poisoning

Excess glycyrrhizin from licorice inhibits 11-beta-hydroxysteroid dehydrogenase type 2 and produces apparent mineralocorticoid excess. Hypertension, hypokalemia, metabolic alkalosis, edema, weakness, and dysrhythmias may occur; stop the source and correct potassium and blood pressure under medical supervision.

Liddle Syndrome

A rare inherited cause of early high blood pressure in which the kidneys retain too much sodium and lose too much potassium. It may begin in childhood or young adulthood and is treated with medicines that block the overactive kidney channel.

Liddle Syndrome Treatment

Treatment of Liddle syndrome lowers blood pressure and the body's excessive sodium retention, usually with a medicine that blocks the overactive kidney channel. Monitoring includes potassium and kidney function; the inherited condition can occur in relatives.

Lidocaine

Lidocaine is a local anaesthetic that blocks voltage-gated sodium channels and, intravenously, can treat selected ventricular arrhythmias; excessive exposure may cause seizures, hypotension, arrhythmia, or cardiac arrest.

LieberküHn's Crypts

Tubular glands in the intestinal lining between villi that contain stem, absorptive, and secretory cells. They renew the lining, produce intestinal substances, and help maintain the gut's protective barrier.

Life Expectancy

The average number of additional years a person of a specified age is expected to live under current mortality conditions.

Life Support

Medical treatments that temporarily replace or support vital body functions, such as mechanical ventilation, dialysis, circulatory support, or artificial nutrition and hydration, when illness prevents adequate function.

Lifetime Risk

The probability that a person will develop a specified disease or experience an outcome during the remainder of their life or over a defined lifetime period.

Li-Fraumeni Syndrome

An inherited condition that greatly increases the chance of developing several cancers, often at a young age. Cancers may include breast cancer, sarcoma, brain tumors, adrenal cancer, or leukemia; specialized screening is usually advised.

Ligament

A dense, fibrous connective tissue band that connects bone to bone, providing passive joint stability and guiding joint motion. Ligaments are composed predominantly of type I collagen fibers (parallel orientation, crimped pattern) and elastin fibers (10-20% in some ligaments), arranged in bundles.

Ligamentum Flavum

A series of paired, thick elastic ligaments connecting the laminae of adjacent vertebrae from the axis to the sacrum, whose high elastin content imparts a characteristic yellow color and helps preserve the upright posture while preventing excessive spinal flexion.

Ligamentum Teres Hepatis

The obliterated fibrous remnant of the embryonic left umbilical vein that carried oxygenated blood from the placenta to the fetus, running within the free inferior border of the falciform ligament from the umbilicus to the left branch of the portal vein.

Alternate Names:
Round Ligament of the Liver

Ligand

Any molecule that binds specifically to a biological receptor, macromolecule, or active site. In pharmacology and physiology, ligands include hormones, neurotransmitters, drugs, and toxins that bind receptors to initiate (agonist), block (antagonist), or modulate signaling.

Ligase

An enzyme that joins two molecules, often using energy from ATP. Ligases help repair DNA, copy genetic material, and build or maintain other important molecules.

Ligation

The surgical process of tying off a blood vessel or duct using a suture or clip to prevent bleeding or block fluid flow.

Ligature

Any cord, wire, rope, fabric, or flexible object used to constrict the neck, bind limbs, suspend the body, or inflict injury. The resulting pale groove-shaped abrasion may be horizontal with petechiae in homicidal strangulation, or oblique and upward in hanging.

Light

Visible electromagnetic radiation; in medicine it is used for examination, phototherapy, imaging, and selected treatments.

Light Chain-Associated Kidney Disease

Kidney injury caused by abnormal immunoglobulin light chains produced by a plasma-cell or B-cell clone. Light chains may cause cast nephropathy, amyloid, or other deposits, leading to proteinuria, acute kidney injury, or chronic kidney disease.

Light-Chain Deposition Disease

A monoclonal plasma-cell disorder in which non-amyloid immunoglobulin light chains deposit along kidney and sometimes other organ structures. It commonly causes proteinuria, high blood pressure, declining kidney function, or nephrotic syndrome.

Light Coagulation

Light coagulation uses intense focused light, usually a laser, to heat and seal tissue or blood vessels.

Light Cycle

A light cycle is the recurring pattern of light and darkness that helps regulate circadian rhythms and biological activity.

Lightening

In late pregnancy, descent of the fetus into the pelvis before labor, which may reduce upper-abdominal pressure but increase pelvic pressure and urinary frequency.

Lighter Fluid Poisoning

Harm from swallowing or breathing lighter fluid, a hydrocarbon. The greatest danger is liquid entering the lungs, causing chemical pneumonia, cough, or breathing difficulty.

Lightheadedness

A feeling of near-fainting, floating, or unsteadiness without necessarily perceiving that the surroundings are spinning; causes include dehydration, low blood pressure, anemia, medications, and heart or neurologic conditions.

Light Microscope

An instrument that uses visible light and lenses to magnify cells, tissues, microorganisms, or other small structures. It is widely used in clinical laboratories, pathology, microbiology, and research.

Light Microscopy

Examination of cells, tissues, microorganisms, or other specimens using visible light and a microscope. Different stains and preparation methods reveal structure, infection, inflammation, blood cells, or abnormal growth.

Light-Near Dissociation

A pupil abnormality in which the pupils constrict when focusing on a nearby object but respond poorly or not at all to light. It can occur with certain nerve disorders, infections, diabetes, or midbrain disease.

Lightning Injuries

Injuries caused by direct or indirect lightning exposure, potentially affecting the heart, nervous system, skin, hearing, muscles, and lungs. Cardiac arrest, neurologic deficits, burns, trauma from falls, and temporary skin branching may occur.

Lightning Pains

Brief, stabbing, electric-shock-like pains caused by irritated or damaged nerves. They classically occur in tabes dorsalis but may also accompany shingles, nerve compression, diabetes, or other neurological disorders.

Light Reflex

Automatic narrowing of the pupil when light enters the eye. It tests the retina, optic nerve, brain pathways, and nerve that controls the pupil; an unequal or absent response may indicate disease.

Light Scattering

Deflection of light when it meets particles, cells, molecules, or irregular structures. Measuring the scattered light can help estimate particle size or concentration in laboratory tests and can affect the appearance of tissues on imaging.

Light's Criteria

A set of laboratory comparisons used to decide whether fluid around the lung is caused by inflammation or disease in the chest rather than by pressure or fluid imbalance elsewhere. Protein and enzyme levels in the fluid are compared with blood levels; the result helps guide further testing and treatment.

Light Therapy

Treatment that uses selected wavelengths or intensity of light for conditions such as some skin disorders, seasonal depression, or neonatal jaundice.

Lignocaine

The international nonproprietary name for lidocaine, a local anesthetic and antiarrhythmic drug.

Likelihood Ratio

A measure of how strongly a test result supports or argues against a disease. A value above one supports disease, a value below one argues against it, and larger changes are more informative.

Lilliputian Hallucination

A visual hallucination of unusually small people,

animals, or objects; it can occur with neurologic, psychiatric, toxic, infectious, or sensory conditions.

Lily Of The Valley Poisoning

Poisoning from eating lily-of-the-valley plant parts, which contain substances that can disrupt the heartbeat. Nausea, vomiting, dizziness, slow or irregular pulse, confusion, or fainting may occur.

Limb

An arm or leg, including its bones, joints, muscles, tendons, nerves, blood vessels, and skin. Limb problems may affect movement, sensation, strength, circulation, or function.

Limb Bud

A limb bud is an embryonic outgrowth that develops into an arm or leg through coordinated signaling, growth, and tissue differentiation.

Limb Development

Limb development is embryonic formation and growth of the bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, and skin of the arms and legs.

Limb Fracture

A break in a bone of an upper or lower limb, assessed according to location, displacement, open or closed status, joint involvement, and associated neurovascular injury.

Limb Girdle

A limb girdle is the skeletal connection of a limb to the trunk, such as the shoulder or pelvic girdle.

Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophies

Limb-girdle muscular dystrophies are inherited muscle diseases causing progressive weakness predominantly around the hips and shoulders, with variable cardiac and respiratory involvement.

Limbic Encephalitis

Inflammation of the limbic system, often presenting subacutely with memory impairment, seizures, psychiatric or behavioral change, and sleep disturbance. It may be autoimmune, paraneoplastic, infectious, or of unknown cause.

Limbic Lobe

A curved region on the inner surface of the brain involved in memory, emotion, motivation, and some responses controlled by the nervous system.

Limbic System

A group of connected brain structures involved in memory, emotion, motivation, learning, and some automatic body responses, such as changes in heart rate during stress.

Limb Injury

Trauma affecting an arm or leg, including injury to bone, joint, muscle, tendon, ligament, nerve, blood vessel, or skin.

Limb-Length Discrepancy

A difference in the lengths of the two legs or, less commonly, the two arms. It may result from growth differences, injury, infection, surgery, or a developmental condition and can affect posture, walking, and joint loading.

Limb Pain

Pain arising from an arm or leg, with causes including trauma, nerve disease, vascular insufficiency, infection, inflammation, and musculoskeletal disorders.

Limb Plethysmography

A noninvasive test measuring changes in limb volume or blood flow, used to evaluate arterial or venous obstruction and sometimes to assess vascular responses.

Limb Prosthesis

A limb prosthesis is an artificial device replacing part or all of an arm or leg to restore mobility, function, appearance, or independence.

Limb Reduction Defects

Birth defects in which part or all of an arm or leg

does not form normally. The missing or shortened part may involve a bone, joint, hand, foot, or the whole limb.

Limbs

The arms and legs, including their bones, joints, muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and skin. Limb problems may affect strength, sensation, movement, circulation, balance, daily activities, or independence.

Limb Salvage

Surgical and reconstructive treatment intended to preserve a threatened arm or leg after severe trauma, infection, vascular compromise, tumor, or other tissue loss. It may involve revascularization, debridement, fixation, soft-tissue coverage, nerve or tendon repair, and rehabilitation.

Limbus

The border where the clear cornea meets the white outer coat of the eye. It contains cells that help renew the corneal surface and may be affected by injury, inflammation, or disease.

Alternate Names:
Corneoscleral Limbus

Limbus Corneae

The corneal limbus is the circular border where the transparent cornea meets the white sclera and conjunctiva, containing stem cells important for corneal repair.

Limited Range Of Motion

Limited range of motion is reduced ability to move a joint through its normal extent because of pain, stiffness, weakness, swelling, or structural change.

Linagliptin

Linagliptin is a DPP-4 inhibitor used with diet and exercise to improve blood glucose control in type 2 diabetes.

Lincomycin

Lincomycin is a lincosamide antibiotic used for selected serious bacterial infections; it can cause antibiotic-associated diarrhea and colitis.

Lindane

Lindane is an organochlorine insecticide formerly used for lice or scabies; neurotoxicity and environmental persistence limit its use.

Lindsay's Nails

A distinctive nail abnormality in which the proximal forty to fifty percent of the nail bed is white and opaque while the distal fifty to sixty percent is pink, red, or brownish. It is strongly associated with chronic kidney disease and uraemia.

Alternate Names:
Half-and-Half Nails; Lindsay Nails

Linea

A line or linear anatomical marking, often used in names such as linea alba or linea nigra.

Linea Alba

A dense, fibrous median collagenous band formed by the interlacing decussating aponeuroses of the external oblique, internal oblique, and transversus abdominis muscles, extending vertically from the xiphoid process to the pubic symphysis.

Linea Aspera

Prominent longitudinal posterior femoral shaft ridge from converging muscle attachment lines. Insertion for adductor magnus, vastus medialis/lateralis, and short head of biceps femoris. Thickest femoral cortex, resisting bending forces. Diverges distally into supracondylar lines.

Linea Nigra

A dark brown or black vertical line appearing on the abdomen during pregnancy, extending from the pubic symphysis to the umbilicus or beyond. Caused by hormonal stimulation of melanocytes, resulting in hyperpigmentation. More prominent in darker-skinned women.

Linear

Arranged in a straight or nearly straight line, de-

scribing the shape or distribution of a skin lesion or eruption.

Linear Accelerator

A machine accelerating electrons to produce high-energy X-rays or electron beams that precisely deliver radiation treatment to selected tumors.

Linear Energy Transfer

The amount of energy that radiation deposits as it travels through tissue. Radiation with higher transfer deposits energy more densely and may cause more biological damage for the same total dose.

Linear Fracture

A narrow break that runs along the length of a bone without moving the pieces far apart or breaking the bone into many fragments. Treatment depends on the bone, the injury's stability, and whether nearby nerves, blood vessels, or organs are affected.

Linear IgA Bullous Dermatosis

An autoimmune blistering disease caused by linear deposition of IgA at the basement membrane zone. It produces tense blisters, sometimes in annular or "string of pearls" patterns, and may be idiopathic or drug-induced.

Linear Nevus Sebaceous Syndrome

A rare disorder involving a linear sebaceous nevus, a skin lesion caused by abnormal skin glands, together with possible eye, brain, or skeletal abnormalities. Clinical features vary with the organs involved.

Lined Canister

A general equipment term for a canister with an inner liner that separates its contents from the canister body. In medical devices, the liner may collect fluids or waste; the term alone does not identify a particular device or its use.

Lines of Blaschko

Non-random developmental cutaneous pathways representing the routes of epidermal cell migration and clonal proliferation during embryogenesis, which become apparent in X-linked mosaic and cutaneous mosaic disorders (such as incontinentia pigmenti and linear epidermal nevi).

Alternate Names:
Blaschko Lines; Blaschko's Tracks

Lines of Zahn

Microscopic and gross alternating pale and dark laminations seen in arterial and intracardiac thrombi formed in rapid pulsatile blood flow, composed of pale layers of platelets and fibrin mesh alternating with dark layers of trapped red blood cells, distinguishing antemortem thrombi from postmortem clots.

Alternate Names:
Zahn Lines; Laminations of Zahn

Linezolid

Linezolid is an oxazolidinone antibiotic that blocks formation of the bacterial 70S initiation complex and treats resistant Gram-positive infections; adverse effects include thrombocytopenia, neuropathy, lactic acidosis, and serotonin interactions.

Lingua

The anatomical Latin term for the tongue, a muscular organ used for chewing, swallowing, speaking, and tasting. The front two-thirds lies in the mouth and the back third lies in the throat; related terms include sublingual, meaning under the tongue.

Lingua Fissurata

Alternate name for fissured tongue, in which grooves form on the tongue surface; see *Fissured Tongue*.

Lingual

Relating to the tongue or the tongue side of a body structure. Lingual muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and surfaces help with taste, speech, swallowing, and movement of food.

Lingual Artery

A branch of the external carotid artery supplying the tongue, floor of mouth, and sublingual structures. It arises anterior to the hypoglossal nerve

and courses deep to the hyoglossus muscle. Lingual artery aneurysm or thrombosis is rare but can cause life-threatening hemorrhage or tongue ischemia.

Lingual Thyroid

A lingual thyroid is thyroid tissue at the base of the tongue caused by failure of normal thyroid descent and may obstruct swallowing or breathing or cause hypothyroidism.

Lingual Tonsil

A prominent unencapsulated aggregation of subepithelial secondary lymphoid tissue located in the lamina propria of the posterior third (base) of the tongue, forming the anteroinferior arc of Waldeyer tonsillar ring. Histologically covered by nonkeratinized stratified squamous epithelium that invaginates to form shallow, non-branching lingual tonsillar crypts, surrounded by rich subepithelial lymphoid follicles with active germinal centers and mucous glands of von Ebner. The lingual tonsil provides mucosal immune surveillance against airborne and ingested antigens entering the oropharynx, producing secretory IgA and activating antigen-specific B- and T-lymphocyte populations. Pathologic enlargement (lingual tonsillar hypertrophy) can arise from chronic laryngopharyngeal reflux, recurrent infection (lingual tonsillitis), or obstructive sleep apnea (OSA), where it may cause oropharyngeal globus sensation, dysphagia, or difficult airway management.

Lingual Tonsils

Plural form; see *Lingual Tonsil*.

Lingua Nigra

Alternate name for black hairy tongue, a usually harmless dark or furry coating caused by elongation and discoloration of tongue papillae; see *Black Hairy Tongue*.

Lingua Villosa Nigra

A benign condition characterized by elongation and dark pigmentation of the filiform papillae of the tongue, often associated with tobacco use, poor oral hygiene, or antimicrobial therapy.

Linguofacial Dyskinesia

Involuntary repetitive movements of the tongue, lips, jaw, or face, often related to medication exposure or neurologic disease; evaluation depends on the pattern and cause.

Liniment

A liquid or semiliquid preparation rubbed onto the skin, usually to provide temporary relief of muscle or joint discomfort. Some contain irritating or warming substances; skin irritation or burns are more likely with broken skin, eye contact, or tight coverings.

Linitis Plastica

A form of stomach cancer that spreads widely through the stomach wall, making it thick and stiff. It may cause early fullness, weight loss, nausea, vomiting, or vague upper-abdominal discomfort.

Linoleic Acid

An essential omega-6 polyunsaturated fatty acid obtained from food. The body uses it to make cell membranes and signaling molecules.

Linolenic Acid

A polyunsaturated fatty acid. Alpha-linolenic acid is an essential omega-3 nutrient from plant foods, while other forms occur in animal tissues and have different roles.

Liothyronine Sodium

A manufactured form of triiodothyronine, an active thyroid hormone, used in selected thyroid disorders. It acts quickly and can cause fast heartbeat, tremor, anxiety, bone loss, or heart strain if excessive.

Lip

The lips are mobile folds of skin and mucosa containing muscle, blood vessels, and sensory nerves; they form the oral seal and assist speech, facial expression, feeding, and swallowing.

Lipase

An enzyme that breaks down fats into smaller molecules. Blood lipase testing is commonly used

when pancreatitis is suspected, although an abnormal result is not specific in every case.

Lipase Test

A lipase test measures a pancreatic digestive enzyme in blood and supports evaluation of acute pancreatitis and selected pancreatic or gastrointestinal disorders.

Lip Cancer

Cancer developing in the tissue of the upper or lower lip. It may appear as a persistent sore, lump, crust, bleeding area, numbness, or color change.

Lip Disease

A disorder of the lips, such as infection, inflammation, ulceration, trauma, pigmentation change, benign tumor, or malignancy.

Lipedema

A long-term disorder causing an unusual, usually symmetrical buildup of painful fat in the legs and sometimes arms. The feet and hands are usually spared, while easy bruising, tenderness, and swelling may occur.

Lipemia Retinalis

A creamy pink-white appearance of retinal blood vessels caused by extremely high triglyceride levels. The appearance usually resolves as triglycerides fall; the finding indicates severe hypertriglyceridemia, which can cause acute pancreatitis.

Lipemic Index

A laboratory estimate of how cloudy a blood sample is because of excess fats. Marked cloudiness can interfere with some test results, sometimes leading to sample review or repeat testing.

Lipid

A structurally heterogeneous class of organic biomolecules defined by their high solubility in nonpolar organic solvents (e.g., chloroform, ether) and relative insolubility in aqueous solutions. In human biochemistry and physiology, lipids are categorized into five major classes: (1) Fatty acids (saturated and unsaturated hydrocarbon chains functioning as primary metabolic fuels via mitochondrial β-oxidation); (2) Triglycerides (triacylglycerols, the predominant molecular form of energy storage sequestered in adipose tissue); (3) Phospholipids (amphipathic molecules, such as phosphatidylcholine and sphingomyelin, forming the structural lipid bilayer of all eukaryotic cellular and organellar membranes); (4) Sterols (primarily cholesterol, an essential membrane fluidity regulator and the obligate precursor for steroid hormones, bile acids, and vitamin D); and (5) Eicosanoids (paracrine signaling mediators including prostaglandins, thromboxanes, and leukotrienes). Because of their hydrophobic nature, circulating lipids are packaged into specialized amphipathic macromolecular complexes called lipoproteins (chylomicrons, VLDL, IDL, LDL, HDL) for vascular transport. Abnormalities in lipid metabolism, uptake, or clearance (dyslipidemia) directly drive atherogenesis, ischemic cardiovascular disease, pancreatitis, and nonalcoholic fatty liver disease.

Lipid A

The part of a substance on the outer surface of some bacteria that triggers a strong immune reaction. Large amounts can contribute to widespread inflammation, shock, and abnormal clotting.

Lipid Bilayer

The double layer of fat-like molecules forming the basic structure of cell membranes. It separates the cell from its surroundings and controls movement of substances.

Lipid Disorder

An abnormal level or handling of fats in the blood or tissues, such as high LDL cholesterol, high triglycerides, or unusually low protective HDL cholesterol.

Lipid Emulsion Therapy

Intravenous fat emulsion used as emergency treatment for severe local-anesthetic systemic toxicity and selected other poisonings. Its mechanisms are not fully established, and it is given as part of mon-

itored emergency care.

Lipid Metabolism

The processes by which the body digests, transports, stores, makes, and breaks down fats for energy, cell membranes, and hormone production.

Lipidosis

A disorder involving abnormal accumulation or metabolism of lipids in tissues, often due to inherited enzyme defects.

Lipid Panel

A blood test that usually measures total cholesterol, LDL cholesterol, HDL cholesterol, and triglycerides. These results are used with other risk factors to assess cardiovascular risk and guide or monitor treatment; no single value determines risk by itself.

Alternate Names:
Lipid Profile; Cholesterol Panel; Coronary Risk Panel; Lipid Profile Test

Lipid Profile

Alternate name; see *Lipid Panel*.

Lipid Profile Test

Alternate name; see *Lipid Panel*.

Lipids

Plural form; see *Lipid*.

Lipid Transport

Movement of fats through blood and tissues by lipoproteins, carrier proteins, or other mechanisms for energy use, storage, membrane formation, and hormone production.

Lip Infection

Infection of the lip caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or an infected wound. It may cause pain, redness, swelling, blisters, cracks, pus, or fever; rapidly spreading swelling or breathing difficulty may occur in a serious infection.

Lipitor

Brand name for atorvastatin; see *Atorvastatin*.

Lip Moisturizer Poisoning

Swallowing a small amount of ordinary lip moisturizer usually causes mild stomach upset or loose stools. Products containing camphor, salicylates, or other medicines can cause serious poisoning.

Lip Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the lip that may be benign or malignant; persistent sores or lumps can be associated with cancer.

Lipoatrophy

Loss of the layer of fat beneath the skin, causing dents or hollow areas. It can follow repeated injections, inflammation, autoimmune disease, HIV treatment, or inherited disorders and may alter medicine absorption at injection sites.

Lipoblastoma

A usually benign tumor of immature adipose tissue occurring mainly in infants and young children; it may be localized or diffuse and can recur if incompletely removed.

Lipodermatosclerosis

A chronic fibrosing inflammatory panniculitis of the subcutaneous adipose tissue of the lower extremity secondary to severe chronic venous insufficiency, producing induration, hyperpigmentation, and the classic "inverted champagne bottle" leg appearance.

Alternate Names:
Sclerosing Panniculitis

Lipodystrophy

Abnormal loss or distribution of body fat. It may be inherited or caused by medicines, metabolic disease, or repeated injections and can lead to insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, or changes in appearance.

Lipodystrophy Syndromes

Rare disorders in which body fat is absent from

some areas, present from birth or lost later, and may collect excessively elsewhere. They can cause severe insulin resistance, diabetes, fatty liver, and very high triglycerides.

Lipofuscin

Lipofuscin is a yellow-brown, non-degradable pigment made of oxidized lipid and protein residues that accumulates in long-lived cells with ageing and in some degenerative diseases.

Lipogranulomatosis

Inflammation in which fat accumulates and triggers organized collections of immune cells called granulomas. It may affect skin, soft tissue, or internal organs and can result from injury, leakage of oily material, or metabolic disease.

Lipohypertrophy

A firm or lumpy buildup of fat under the skin, often at repeated insulin-injection sites. Injecting into these areas can change how insulin is absorbed.

Lipoid Nephrosis

An older name for a kidney disorder, most often in children, in which the kidney filters leak large amounts of protein into the urine. It can cause swelling around the eyes, legs, or abdomen.

Lipoidosis

Abnormal buildup of fats within cells or tissues, usually because a metabolic pathway cannot process or transport them normally. It may be inherited or acquired and can damage organs such as the liver, nerves, or kidneys.

Lipoid Pneumonia

Lung inflammation caused by oil or fat entering the airways or building up in lung tissue. It may follow inhalation or swallowing of oil-based products and can cause cough, breathlessness, fever, or chest changes on imaging.

Lipolysis

Breakdown of stored body fat into fatty acids and glycerol so they can be used for energy. Fasting and stress hormones increase this process, while insulin generally reduces it.

Lipoma

A benign tumor of mature fat cells, usually a slow-growing, soft, movable, painless lump beneath the skin of the trunk, neck, or limbs. Less commonly, lipomas develop deeper within muscle or other tissues.

Lipomastia

Alternate name; see *Pseudogynecomastia*.

Lipomatosis

A condition in which mature fat tissue grows in multiple or broad areas rather than forming one separate lump. It may be symmetrical, involve the trunk or limbs, and be difficult to remove when it extends between nearby structures.

Lipomatous Neoplasm

A growth made partly or mainly of fat cells. It may be noncancerous, like a lipoma, or cancerous, like a liposarcoma; deep, firm, painful, or rapidly enlarging masses are more concerning for malignancy.

Lipophilicity

Lipophilicity is the tendency of a substance to dissolve in fats or oils rather than water, influencing drug absorption and distribution.

Lipopolysaccharide

Lipopolysaccharide is the outer-membrane endotoxin of Gram-negative bacteria, consisting of lipid A, core polysaccharide, and O antigen; circulating lipid A can trigger cytokine release, fever, shock, and disseminated inflammation.

Lipoprotein

A particle made of fat and protein that carries cholesterol and other fats through the blood. Different types transport dietary fat, triglycerides, or cholesterol; high LDL levels can contribute to artery disease.

Lipoprotein A

Alternate spelling; see *Lipoprotein(a)*.

Lipoprotein(a)

A cholesterol-carrying particle similar to LDL. Its level is mostly inherited, and a high level raises the risk of heart and blood vessel disease and narrowing of the aortic valve.

Alternate Names:
Lp(a)

Lipoprotein Analysis

Laboratory measurement of blood particles that carry fats, such as LDL, HDL, or lipoprotein(a), to assess cholesterol transport or heart and blood vessel risk.

Lipoprotein Lipase

An enzyme on capillary walls that breaks down triglycerides in chylomicrons and very-low-density lipoproteins so tissues can use or store the fatty acids. Its activity is regulated by nutritional and hormonal signals.

Lipoprotein Metabolism

The body's production, transport, modification, and removal of particles that carry cholesterol and other fats through the bloodstream.

Liposarcoma

A malignant tumor of fat cells, usually arising in the deep soft tissues of the thigh or retroperitoneum; well-differentiated, myxoid, and pleomorphic subtypes are recognized.

Liposarcoma Of The Breast

A rare malignant mesenchymal tumor with adipocytic differentiation arising in breast soft tissue. Diagnosis requires histopathologic and molecular evaluation, and treatment is generally wide excision with sarcoma-focused care.

Liposomal Amphotericin B

A liposomal formulation of amphotericin B used in the treatment of severe systemic fungal infections, with reduced nephrotoxicity compared to conventional amphotericin B. The liposomal formulation encapsulates amphotericin B within lipid vesicles, which alters the drug's biodistribution and reduces renal tubular damage.

Liposome

A liposome is a tiny vesicle made of a lipid bilayer that can carry medicines or other substances into or around the body.

Liposuction

A surgical procedure that uses a cannula and suction to remove localized deposits of subcutaneous fat for body contouring. It is not a treatment for obesity or a substitute for diet and exercise. Risks may include bleeding, infection, contour irregularity, fluid accumulation or shifts, sensory changes, and anesthesia-related complications.

Alternate Names:
Lipoplasty

Lips

The paired movable folds surrounding the opening of the mouth, involved in speech, facial expression, eating, and oral sensation.

Lipschütz Bodies

Older name for sudden, painful ulcers of the vulva or lower vagina that are not caused by a sexually transmitted infection. Also called *Lipschütz ulcers*.

Lip Swelling

Enlargement of one or both lips caused by local injury, infection, inflammation, dental disease, medication, or angioedema. Sudden swelling with tongue or throat swelling, breathing difficulty, wheezing, faintness, or widespread hives may indicate a severe allergic reaction.

Liquefaction

Conversion of a solid or partly solid material into liquid, such as tissue breakdown during liquefactive necrosis or melting of a substance.

Liquefactive Necrosis

A pattern of tissue death in which enzymes digest dead cells until the area becomes soft or liquid. It commonly occurs in brain injury and some infections and may leave a fluid-filled cavity.

Liquid Bandage for Lacerations

Use of a topical skin adhesive to close selected small, clean, shallow wounds with edges that can be brought together easily. It forms a protective film that wears off as the skin heals; it is not suitable for every wound.

Alternate Names:
Tissue Adhesive Closure; Topical Skin Glue; Cyanoacrylate Liquid Bandage

Liquid Biopsy

A blood or other body-fluid test that looks for tumor-related material, such as circulating tumor DNA or tumor cells. It may help detect cancer changes or guide treatment in selected situations, but it does not replace tissue biopsy in every case.

Liquid Chromatography

A laboratory method that separates dissolved substances as a liquid carries them through a material that interacts differently with each substance. It is used to identify or measure medicines, hormones, metabolites, proteins, and toxins.

Liquid Diet

A diet consisting partly or entirely of liquids; clear-liquid and full-liquid diets differ in allowed foods and may be prescribed temporarily for procedures, illness, or swallowing or digestive problems.

Liquid Incense

A scented liquid product that may contain solvents, oils, or other chemicals. Swallowing or inhaling it can cause irritation, drowsiness, vomiting, seizures, or lung injury; the product container is needed for poison-control assessment.

Liquid Nitrogen

Liquid nitrogen is extremely cold nitrogen used to freeze tissue in cryotherapy; contact can cause frostbite and its gas can displace oxygen.

Liquor

A historical medical term for a body fluid, especially cerebrospinal fluid (*liquor cerebrospinalis*). In pharmacy, it can also mean a liquid medicinal preparation.

LI-RADS

A standardized system for reporting liver-imaging findings in people at increased risk of liver cancer, especially those with cirrhosis. Its categories estimate how likely a finding is to be cancer and help guide follow-up or biopsy.

Liraglutide

Liraglutide is a GLP-1 receptor agonist used to improve glucose control in type 2 diabetes and, at some doses, support weight management.

Lisch Nodule

A small, harmless, brownish or yellow-tan bump that develops on the iris (the colored part of the eye). Named after the eye doctor who first described them, Lisch nodules do not affect vision, but they serve as a classic physical indicator used by doctors to help diagnose neurofibromatosis type 1 (a genetic disorder causing nerve tumors).

Lisch Nodules

Plural form; see *Lisch Nodule*.

Lisfranc Fracture

A severe midfoot injury characterized by fracture, subluxation, or dislocation of the tarsometatarsal joints, classically involving disruption of the strong Lisfranc ligament connecting the medial cuneiform to the base of the second metatarsal bone.

Alternate Names:
Lisfranc Joint Complex Injury; Tarsometatarsal Fracture-Dislocation

Lisfranc Injury

A spectrum of traumatic fracture-dislocations in-

volving the tarsometatarsal articulation of the midfoot, typically disrupting the critical Lisfranc ligament extending between the medial cuneiform and the base of the second metatarsal.

Lisinopril

Lisinopril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension, heart failure, and kidney protection in some diabetes; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

Lissencephaly

A birth condition in which the brain's surface has few or no normal folds because nerve cells did not move to their usual positions during development. It can cause seizures, severe developmental impairment, feeding problems, and movement difficulties.

Listeria

Listeria is a genus of bacteria; L. monocytogenes can cause foodborne illness, bloodstream infection, and meningitis, especially in pregnancy, older adults, and people with weakened immunity.

Alternate Names:
Listeria Species

Listeria Infection

An infection caused by Listeria bacteria, usually acquired from contaminated food. It may cause fever, muscle aches, diarrhea, or vomiting; infection can be severe in pregnancy, newborns, older adults, and people with weakened immune systems.

Listeria Monocytogenes

A gram-positive, facultatively anaerobic rod that causes listeriosis, a foodborne infection. The organism is transmitted through contaminated food, particularly deli meats, soft cheeses, and ready-to-eat foods. It can grow at refrigeration temperatures.

Listeriosis

An infection caused by the bacterium Listeria monocytogenes, usually from contaminated food. It can cause fever, muscle aches, diarrhea, or vomiting. Sometimes the bacteria spread from the gut into the blood or brain, causing serious illness. Infection during pregnancy may lead to pregnancy loss, early birth, or serious illness in the newborn. Older adults and people with weakened immune systems are also at higher risk of severe illness.

Listeriosis In Pregnancy

A foodborne infection that may cause only fever, tiredness, or muscle aches in the pregnant person but can spread to the fetus. It can cause miscarriage, stillbirth, premature birth, or severe infection in the newborn.

Lithiasis

The formation or presence of stones (calculi) in an organ or duct. The term is often named for the site, such as nephrolithiasis in the kidney, ureterolithiasis in the ureter, or cholelithiasis in the gallbladder.

Lithium

Lithium is a mood stabilizer used mainly for bipolar disorder and selected augmentation treatment; its narrow therapeutic range requires monitoring for tremor, thyroid or renal dysfunction, dehydration, drug interactions, and toxicity.

Lithium Carbonate

A mood-stabilizing medicine used mainly to treat bipolar disorder and reduce the risk of manic or depressive episodes; serum levels, kidney function, thyroid function, and drug interactions require monitoring.

Lithium Nephropathy

Kidney injury related to long-term or toxic lithium exposure, most often causing impaired urine concentration and excessive urination, and sometimes chronic tubulointerstitial scarring or hyperparathyroidism. Monitoring lithium levels, kidney function, and calcium helps reduce risk.

Lithium Toxicity

Poisoning caused by too much lithium in the body, often after dehydration, illness, a dose change, or a medicine interaction. Nausea, diarrhea, worsening tremor, weakness, confusion, poor coordination,

seizures, or reduced consciousness may occur.

Lithotomy

A surgical procedure for removing a stone, or the position with the hips and knees flexed and legs supported.

Lithotomy Position

A supine position in which the hips and knees are flexed and the legs are raised and supported to provide access to the pelvis and perineum.

Lithotripsy

Fragmentation of a stone using energy delivered from outside the body or through an endoscope. Shock-wave lithotripsy is used for selected urinary tract stones; laser and other forms may be used during endoscopic stone-removal procedures. Fragments may pass spontaneously or require removal, depending on the stone and procedure.

Alternate Names:
Stone Fragmentation

Lithotripsy Probe

A device that fragments a stone using mechanical, ultrasonic, laser, or shock-wave energy during a stone-removal procedure.

Lithotripter

A device that breaks urinary, bile-duct, or other stones into smaller pieces using shock waves, laser energy, or another treatment method.

Lithotripter Probe

A specialized probe delivering mechanical, electrical, or laser energy to break urinary or bile-duct stones into fragments that can be removed.

Litmus

A dye that changes color with acidity or alkalinity and is used as a simple pH indicator.

Little Area

The highly vascular region of the anterior nasal septum where several arteries meet and where most anterior nosebleeds originate.

Little's Disease

An older name for spastic cerebral palsy, a condition caused by early brain injury or abnormal development that produces stiff muscles and movement difficulties, mainly in the legs. It is not progressive, although needs change over time.

Live Attenuated Vaccines

Vaccines containing weakened forms of viruses or bacteria. They usually produce a strong, long-lasting immune response without causing illness in healthy people, but some are unsuitable for people with severely weakened immune systems or during certain pregnancies.

Alternate Names:
Live Vaccines

Live Birth

A live birth is delivery of an infant showing signs of life such as breathing, heartbeat, or movement, regardless of gestational age.

Livedoid Vasculopathy

A chronic thrombotic occlusion of small dermal vessels, usually affecting the lower legs, ankles, and feet. It causes painful purpuric lesions and ulcers that may heal with porcelain-white, stellate scars called atrophie blanche; it is not primarily a vasculitis.

Livedo Racemosa

A persistent, irregular, branching net-like pattern of reddish-blue skin caused by disease of small or medium blood vessels. It may occur with autoimmune, clotting, inflammatory, or other systemic disorders.

Livedo Reticularis

A usually regular, netlike pattern of reddish-blue or violaceous discoloration caused by altered blood flow in cutaneous vessels. It often appears on the limbs and may fade with warming. It is a skin finding rather than a diagnosis; persistent or unexplained livedo can accompany vascular, autoimmune, infectious, or clotting disorders.

Liver

The largest internal organ, beneath the right ribs. It processes nutrients, makes bile to help digest fats, stores energy, helps regulate blood chemicals, and breaks down medicines and harmful substances.

Liver Abscess

A pocket of pus in the liver, usually caused by bacteria or the amoeba *Entamoeba histolytica*. It may cause fever, chills, or pain under the right ribs. Bacterial liver abscesses are called pyogenic; amoebic abscesses are caused by a parasite that usually first infects the intestine.

Liver Anatomy and Physiology

Alternate name; see *Liver*.

Liver Biopsy

Percutaneous, transjugular, or laparoscopic sampling of liver tissue for histologic evaluation when noninvasive tests do not answer the clinical question. It may stage fibrosis or characterize inflammation, fatty liver disease, infiltrative disease, or a mass; complications include pain and bleeding.

Liver Cancer

A malignant tumor involving the liver. Primary liver cancers begin in liver cells or bile-duct cells, with hepatocellular carcinoma the most common primary type in adults. Cancer that begins elsewhere and spreads to the liver is metastatic liver cancer and is more common than primary liver cancer. Risk factors for primary liver cancer include cirrhosis, chronic viral hepatitis, alcohol-related liver injury, fatty-liver inflammation, and some toxins.

Alternate Names:
Hepatic Malignancy

Liver Cancer Treatment

Treatment of liver cancer may include surgery, ablation, embolization, radiation, immunotherapy, targeted therapy, chemotherapy, or transplantation according to tumor type, stage, liver function, and overall health.

Liver Circulation

The liver receives oxygen-rich blood from the hepatic artery and nutrient-rich blood from the portal vein. Blood passes through liver tissue and leaves through the hepatic veins to the heart.

Liver Cirrhosis

Alternate name; see *Cirrhosis*.

Liver Damage

Liver damage is injury or loss of liver-cell function caused by infection, alcohol, medicines, toxins, fatty disease, autoimmune disease, or other processes.

Liver Disease

Any acute or chronic pathological condition that damages hepatic parenchyma, disrupts hepatocellular metabolic architecture, or impairs biliary drainage and microvascular perfusion. Etiologies are diverse: viral infections (hepatitis B, C, D); toxic and chemical insults (alcohol-associated liver disease, drug-induced liver injury [DILI, notably acetaminophen toxicity]); metabolic derangements (metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease [MASLD / MASH]); autoimmune conditions (autoimmune hepatitis, primary biliary cholangitis [PBC], primary sclerosing cholangitis [PSC]); genetic inborn errors of metabolism (hemochromatosis, Wilson disease, alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency); vascular disorders (Budd-Chiari syndrome, portal vein thrombosis); and neoplastic transformations (hepatocellular carcinoma, cholangiocarcinoma). Chronic ongoing injury triggers hepatic stellate cell transdifferentiation into collagen-secreting myofibroblasts, resulting in progressive fibrosis, architectural distortion, and liver cirrhosis complicated by portal hypertension, ascites, hepatic encephalopathy, variceal hemorrhage, hepatorenal syndrome, and acute-on-chronic liver failure.

Liver Disease and Pregnancy

Liver disorders may begin during pregnancy or predate it and can affect maternal health, fetal growth, medication choices, and timing of delivery. Abnormal liver tests, jaundice, severe itching, right-upper-abdominal pain, vomiting, or high blood pressure

can indicate a serious pregnancy-related disorder.

Liver Disease Diet

An individualized eating plan for a person with liver disease. It may address adequate energy and protein, sodium or fluid intake, alcohol avoidance, and nutrient deficiencies according to the condition.

Liver Diseases

Plural form; see *Liver Disease*.

Liver Disorder

Any disease affecting the liver, including fatty liver, viral hepatitis, autoimmune disease, scarring, blockage of bile flow, or cancer. Symptoms may be absent or include jaundice, fatigue, pain, swelling, or abnormal blood tests.

Liver Dysfunction

Liver dysfunction is reduced ability of the liver to perform tasks such as processing nutrients, making proteins, clearing toxins, and producing bile.

Liver Elastography

A noninvasive ultrasound- or MRI-based test that estimates liver stiffness. It helps assess scarring (fibrosis) and cirrhosis, but stiffness can also rise from inflammation, congestion, or other conditions; results are considered with other findings.

Liver Enzymes

Blood measurements including ALT, AST, alkaline phosphatase, and GGT that can suggest liver or bile-duct injury. Abnormal results are considered with symptoms, medicines, imaging, and other tests.

Liver Failure

A life-threatening loss of the liver's ability to make proteins, process nutrients, remove harmful substances, and regulate blood clotting. It can cause jaundice, bleeding, confusion, swelling, and multiple-organ failure.

Liver Fibrosis

Excessive scar formation in the liver after ongoing injury or inflammation. It can progress to cirrhosis, reduce liver function, and result from viral hepatitis, alcohol, fatty liver, immune disease, or other causes.

Liver Fluke

A parasitic flatworm that infects the liver or bile ducts, including Clonorchis, Opisthorchis, and Fasciola species.

Liver Function

The liver's ability to process nutrients and medicines, make bile and blood proteins, regulate blood chemicals, and remove harmful substances. Blood tests can assess some aspects of liver function and injury.

Liver Function Test

Singular variant; see *Liver Function Tests*.

Liver Function Tests

Blood tests used to assess liver injury, bile-flow abnormalities, and liver synthetic function. They commonly include aminotransferases, alkaline phosphatase, bilirubin, albumin, and clotting tests; results must be interpreted together with the clinical context.

Liver Health

The ability of the liver to perform its many jobs, including processing nutrients and medicines, making important blood proteins, producing bile, storing energy, and helping remove harmful substances. Alcohol, infections, obesity, medicines, and other diseases can damage the liver.

Liver Infection

Infection of liver tissue, such as a viral hepatitis infection or a bacterial liver abscess. Symptoms may include fever, tiredness, nausea, right-upper-abdominal pain, jaundice, or confusion.

Liver Lobule

A small repeating unit of liver tissue in which blood from branches of the portal vein and hepatic artery flows past liver cells toward a central vein, while bile flows in the opposite direction.

Liver Mass

An unusual area found in the liver, often on an ultrasound, CT scan, or MRI. It may be a harmless cyst or growth, a primary liver cancer, or cancer that spread from elsewhere; further testing may be needed.

Liver Metastases

Liver metastases are cancer deposits that spread to the liver from another primary tumor and may cause no symptoms or produce pain, weight loss, or liver dysfunction.

Liver Neoplasm

A liver neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the liver that may be benign or malignant and may arise from liver cells, bile ducts, or metastasis from another cancer.

Liver Pain

Discomfort in the upper-right abdomen that may arise from the liver, gallbladder, bile ducts, stomach, muscles, or other organs. Persistent pain, jaundice, fever, vomiting, or confusion may indicate an underlying illness.

Liver Regeneration

The liver's ability to restore lost tissue by growing and reorganizing remaining cells after injury or partial surgical removal.

Liver Scan

A nuclear medicine or imaging examination of the liver used to evaluate its size, shape, tissue distribution, focal lesions, blood flow, or selected functional abnormalities.

Liver Shunt

An abnormal or surgically created channel that diverts blood around the liver, such as a portosystemic shunt; it can reduce detoxification and contribute to hepatic encephalopathy.

Liver Spots

Alternate name; see *Age Spots*.

Liver Transplant

Surgical replacement of a diseased liver with a healthy liver or part of a liver from a donor.

Liver Transplantation

Surgery to replace a severely diseased or failing liver with a healthy donor liver or part of one. It may be used for advanced liver disease, sudden liver failure, or selected liver cancers; lifelong medicines help prevent rejection.

Living Donor

Individual who donates an organ (kidney, liver segment, or other tissue) while alive for transplantation into a recipient.

Living Will

A type of advance directive that records a person's preferences for future medical treatment if the person cannot communicate or decide.

Livor Mortis

Post-mortem purplish-red discoloration of dependent body parts resulting from gravitational settling of blood in uncompressed capillaries and small veins following cessation of circulation.

Alternate Names:
Hypostasis; Postmortem Staining

Lizard Bite

A puncture or tissue injury caused by a lizard; care includes cleaning and assessing for infection, tetanus, venom exposure, and significant tissue damage according to the species and circumstances.

LLETZ

A procedure that uses a thin electrically heated wire loop to remove abnormal tissue from the cervix. The tissue is examined in the laboratory and the procedure can treat precancerous cervical changes.

Alternate Names:
LEEP (loop Electrosurgical Excision Procedure)

Lloyd-Davies Position

A modified lithotomy position in which the patient

lies supine with lower-profile leg support (less hip flexion) combined with a Trendelenburg tilt. It is commonly used for pelvic and colorectal surgery, allowing simultaneous abdominal and perineal surgical access.

Loading Dose

The first, sometimes larger, dose of a medicine given to reach a helpful amount in the body quickly. It is followed by regular maintenance doses and is selected according to the medicine and the patient's condition.

Loa Loa

A parasitic worm spread by deer flies in parts of West and Central Africa. Adult worms move under the skin and sometimes across the surface of the eye. Infection can cause temporary, itchy swellings under the skin.

Lobaplatin

Lobaplatin is a platinum-based antineoplastic drug used in some countries and studied for its ability to damage cancer-cell DNA.

Lobar Hemorrhage

Bleeding into one of the large regions, or lobes, of the brain. It can result from long-term high blood pressure, fragile blood vessels, blood-thinning medicines, injury, or other conditions and may cause sudden headache, weakness, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Lobar Pneumonia

Pneumonia affecting a large section or an entire lobe of the lung. It can cause fever, cough, chest pain, breathlessness, and low oxygen and may be caused by bacteria, viruses, or other organisms.

Lobe

A lobe is a distinct subdivision of an organ or structure, such as a lung, liver, brain, thyroid, or gland.

Lobectomy

Surgical removal of a lobe of an organ. Most commonly lung lobectomy (removal of one lobe of the lung, performed for lung cancer, bronchiectasis, abscess, or benign tumor) or temporal lobectomy (removal of the anterior temporal lobe for drug-resistant temporal lobe epilepsy).

Lobomycosis

A rare, chronic fungal infection of the skin and subcutaneous tissue caused by *Lacazia loboi*. It produces slowly growing papules, nodules, or plaques, often with a keloid-like appearance, usually on exposed skin in tropical regions of Central and South America.

Alternate Names:
Lacaziosis; Jorge Lobo Disease; Keloidal Blastomycosis

Lobotomy

A historical brain operation that cut or damaged nerve connections in the front part of the brain. It was once used for severe mental illness but caused serious changes in personality and ability and is no longer an accepted treatment.

Lobular Capillary Hemangioma

Alternate name; see *Pyogenic Granuloma*.

Lobular Carcinoma

A breast cancer arising in milk-producing lobular cells that has invaded surrounding breast tissue; this is invasive lobular carcinoma. Lobular carcinoma in situ is a separate noninvasive lesion associated with increased breast-cancer risk.

Lobular Carcinoma In Situ

An abnormal proliferation of cells confined to the breast lobules, without invasion into surrounding tissue. Classic LCIS is not invasive breast cancer and seldom progresses directly, but it increases future breast-cancer risk in either breast.

Lobule

A small anatomical subdivision or structural unit within a larger bodily organ, separated from neighboring units by thin sheets of connective tissue. For example, the liver is composed of thousands of

microscopic lobules that filter blood and produce bile, while the breasts and lungs contain lobules specialized for milk production and air exchange, respectively.

Lobules

Plural form; see *Lobule*.

Local

Limited to a particular body site or region rather than involving the whole body. A local treatment or symptom affects the treated or affected area, although nearby or wider effects can sometimes occur.

Local Anesthesia

Temporary loss of sensation, especially pain, in a small, specific body area caused by a local anesthetic applied to the surface or injected nearby. The person usually remains conscious, although sedation may be added; excessive dosing or accidental injection into a blood vessel can cause seizures, heart problems, or other toxicity.

Alternate Names:
Local Anaesthesia

Local Anesthetic Systemic Toxicity

A dangerous reaction when a local numbing medicine enters the bloodstream in excessive amounts. Early signs include tingling around the mouth, ringing in the ears, dizziness, or agitation; seizures and heart problems can follow.

Local Anesthetic Toxicity

Harm from too much local anesthetic in the bloodstream. Early warning signs include ringing in the ears, numbness around the mouth, dizziness, or agitation; seizures, low blood pressure, abnormal rhythms, or cardiac arrest can follow. Treatment may include airway support and intravenous lipid emulsion.

Local Invasion

Growth of a tumor into nearby tissues rather than only at its original site. It is a feature of malignant behavior and differs from distant metastasis.

Localised

Confined to a limited area or a small number of adjacent body sites rather than widespread.

Localization

Determining the body site responsible for a symptom, sign, lesion, or function. Accurate localization helps guide examination, imaging, diagnosis, treatment, surgery, rehabilitation, and assessment of nerve or organ damage.

Localized

Limited to one particular area, organ, or body site without evidence of distant spread. A localized disease may still be serious, but treatment can sometimes focus on the affected area.

Alternate Names:
Localized Disease

Localized Edema

Swelling confined to a particular body region because of fluid accumulation, commonly caused by venous or lymphatic obstruction, inflammation, trauma, allergy, or local infection.

Localized Epidermolysis Bullosa

An inherited or acquired blistering disorder limited mainly to particular areas of skin or mucosa; friction can cause blisters, erosions, pain, and infection, and the subtype determines management.

Localized Lipodystrophy

Loss of subcutaneous fat in a limited body area, sometimes after injections, trauma, inflammation, pressure, or panniculitis. It may be cosmetic or reflect an underlying local or systemic disorder.

Localized Scleroderma

An autoimmune skin disorder causing localized thickening and hardening of the skin, with or without involvement of deeper tissues; it differs from systemic sclerosis.

Local Therapy

Local therapy treats a disease at or near the af-

fected area rather than throughout the body, for example with a cream, injection, surgery, or focused radiation.

Lochia

The normal vaginal discharge after childbirth. It is usually red and bloody at first, then becomes pink or brown, and finally yellowish or white over the following weeks. Heavy bleeding, large clots, fever, or foul odor can indicate hemorrhage or infection.

Locked-In Syndrome

A condition in which a person remains conscious and able to think but is almost completely paralyzed and cannot speak. Some people can communicate by blinking or moving their eyes.

Alternate Names:
Pseudocoma; De-Efferented State

Lock Jaw

Alternate name; see *Lockjaw*.

Lockjaw

A common name for trismus, difficulty opening the mouth because of jaw-muscle tightening or spasm. It can occur with tetanus, dental infection, jaw injury, or other conditions.

Alternate Names:
Trismus

Locomotion

Movement of an organism or person from one place to another using coordinated muscles, bones, nerves, and balance systems.

Locomotive System

The musculoskeletal and nervous systems working together to produce posture, balance, and movement from place to place.

Locomotor Ataxia

A late manifestation of untreated tertiary syphilis (neurosyphilis) caused by infection with Treponema pallidum, involving progressive degeneration of the dorsal columns (fasciculus gracilis and cuneatus) and dorsal roots of the spinal cord.

Alternate Names:
Syphilitic Myelopathy; Posterior Sclerosis

Locoregional

Affecting a defined local area and nearby tissues or lymph nodes, without necessarily involving the whole body.

Locus

The specific location of a gene or other DNA sequence on a chromosome. It is described using the chromosome number and a coded position on its short or long arm.

Locus Ceruleus

A small brainstem region containing nerve cells that release norepinephrine. It helps regulate alertness, attention, stress responses, sleep, and some automatic body functions.

Alternate Names:
Locus Coeruleus

Locus Coeruleus

The locus coeruleus is a brainstem nucleus whose noradrenaline-producing neurons influence arousal, attention, stress, sleep, and pain.

Locus Minoris Resistentiae

Latin for a site of lesser resistance, meaning a body area considered more vulnerable to injury, infection, or disease because of local weakness or prior damage.

Lod Score

A statistical measure used in genetic linkage analysis to compare how likely it is that two genetic markers are inherited together rather than independently. Higher positive scores provide stronger evidence of linkage in the studied family.

Loeffler Endocarditis

Eosinophil-mediated endomyocardial disease, usually associated with hypereosinophilic syndrome, in which eosinophil infiltration and degranulation cause myocardial or endocardial injury, mural thrombus,

and later endocardial fibrosis. It can produce restrictive physiology, valvular regurgitation, emboli, and heart failure; the disease may progress through necrotic, thrombotic, and fibrotic stages.

Alternate Names:
Eosinophilic Endomyocardial Fibrosis; Fibroplastic Parietal Endocarditis

Loeffler Syndrome

A benign, self-limiting pulmonary syndrome characterized by transient migratory pulmonary infiltrates, peripheral blood eosinophilia, dry cough, and low-grade fever, classically triggered by the transpulmonary larval migration of helminth parasites such as Ascaris lumbricoides.

Alternate Names:
Simple Pulmonary Eosinophilia; Loeffler Pneumonia

Loeys-Dietz Syndrome

Loeys-Dietz syndrome is an inherited connective-tissue disorder associated with arterial aneurysm or dissection, distinctive skeletal and craniofacial features, allergic disease, and variable organ involvement. Management often includes lifelong vascular imaging and coordinated specialist care.

Alternate Names:
LDS

Löfgren Syndrome

A sudden form of sarcoidosis causing swollen lymph nodes near the lungs, tender red lumps on the shins, and painful swollen ankles. It often improves over time; involvement of other organs can occur.

Log Roll Test

A physical examination manoeuvre used to assess hip joint pathology. With the patient supine and the lower extremity in full extension, the examiner passively rolls the thigh internally and externally; pain elicited during rotation indicates intra-articular hip pathology, such as femoral neck fracture, labral tear, or synovitis.

Loiasis

Loiasis is infection with the filarial worm Loa loa, transmitted by deerflies and sometimes causing transient eye-worm migration and localized swelling.

Loin

The area of the lower back between the ribs and pelvis, including the side of the body called the flank. Pain there may come from muscles, the spine, kidneys, or nearby organs.

Lomentospora Prolificans

An environmental mold that can cause severe disseminated infection, especially in people with weakened immune systems. It is often resistant to antifungal medicines.

Alternate Names:
Scedosporium Prolificans

Lomotil Overdose

Taking too much diphenoxylate–atropine can cause extreme sleepiness, confusion, dry mouth, fast heartbeat, slowed breathing, coma, or delayed worsening, especially in children.

Lomustine

Lomustine is an oral chemotherapy medicine used for selected brain tumors and other cancers; delayed low blood counts are an important risk.

Lonafarnib

A farnesyltransferase-inhibiting medicine used for selected progeroid syndromes, in which abnormal protein processing contributes to premature aging features. It can cause gastrointestinal symptoms, liver abnormalities, and drug interactions.

Long-Acting Beta-2 Agonists

Inhaled medicines that keep the airways relaxed for many hours and reduce breathing symptoms in asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease. For asthma, they are used with an inhaled corticosteroid, not alone.

Long-Acting Reversible Contraception

Contraceptive methods that prevent pregnancy for months to years without daily action, mainly progestin implants and intrauterine devices. They can

be removed when pregnancy is desired or another method is preferred.

Alternate Names:
LARC

Long Arm Of A Chromosome

The longer segment of a chromosome, designated q, extending from the centromere toward the chromosome's end.

Long Bones

Bones that are longer than they are wide, such as the femur, tibia, humerus, and radius. Their shafts provide support and leverage for movement, while their ends form or help form joints; bone marrow inside them produces blood cells.

Long COVID

A condition following probable or confirmed SARS-CoV-2 infection, usually beginning about 3 months after illness and lasting at least 2 months without another explanation. Symptoms may persist from the acute illness or appear after recovery, and can fluctuate or recur. Common features include fatigue, shortness of breath, and cognitive dysfunction, sometimes affecting everyday functioning.

Longitudinal Axis

An imaginary line running along the length of a body or body part, from one end to the other. Rotation around this line is called longitudinal rotation.

Longitudinal Section

A cut or image made along the long axis of an organ, limb, vessel, or other structure.

Longitudinal Studies

Longitudinal studies follow participants or measurements over time to examine change, incidence, exposures, outcomes, and temporal relationships.

Longitudinal Vaginal Septum

A wall of tissue that divides the vagina lengthwise, present from birth. It may cause painful sex, difficulty inserting tampons, blocked menstrual flow, or no symptoms. It can occur with an unusually shaped uterus and may be removed surgically when it causes problems.

Long QT Syndrome

An electrical disorder of the heart that affects how heart muscle cells recharge between beats. On an electrocardiogram (ECG), this delayed electrical recovery is seen as an unusually long interval between the Q and T waves. Because this delay leaves the heart vulnerable to chaotic electrical disruptions, it can trigger sudden, dangerous, irregular heartbeats that cause fainting, seizures, or sudden cardiac arrest, often provoked by exercise, intense emotion, or sudden loud noises.

Alternate Names:
LQTS; Romano-Ward Syndrome

Long-Sightedness

Hyperopia, a refractive error in which distant objects may be clearer than near objects and accommodation is required for focusing.

Long-Term Care

Ongoing help with daily activities, nursing, medical needs, or supervision for a person who cannot live fully independently. Care may be provided at home, in assisted living, or in a nursing facility and changes as needs evolve.

Long-Term Care Facility

A residential or care setting providing ongoing assistance, nursing, rehabilitation, or personal care to people who cannot live independently or need sustained support.

Long-Term Complications Of Diabetes

Chronic complications of diabetes caused mainly by vascular and metabolic injury, including retinopathy, kidney disease, neuropathy, cardiovascular disease, and foot disease.

Long-Term Effect

A health effect that develops or persists after prolonged exposure, treatment, or disease. It may be beneficial, harmful, or uncertain.

Long-Term Memory

Information retained for a long period, from hours or days to a lifetime. It includes explicit memories of facts and events and implicit skills or habits.

Long-Term Potentiation

Long-term potentiation is a lasting increase in the strength of communication between nerve cells after repeated stimulation and is important in learning and memory.

Long-Term Rehabilitation

Ongoing rehabilitation for chronic disease, lasting disability, or persistent injury. Goals include maintaining function, preventing complications, adapting activities, and supporting independence and quality of life.

Loop Diuretic

A powerful class of water-excreting medications—such as furosemide—that act on a specific U-shaped part of the kidney tubules called the loop of Henle. By blocking the kidneys from reabsorbing salt and water, loop diuretics stimulate the kidneys to produce large volumes of urine, helping rapidly clear excess fluid from the body in conditions such as congestive heart failure, severe leg swelling (edema), liver cirrhosis, and kidney disease.

Loop Diuretics

Plural form; see *Loop Diuretic*.

Loop Electrosurgical Excision Procedure

A procedure that uses a thin heated wire loop to remove abnormal tissue from the cervix. It both treats precancerous cervical changes and provides tissue for laboratory examination. Bleeding, infection, narrowing of the cervix, and a small increased risk of later premature birth can occur.

Alternate Names:
LEEP; Large Loop Excision of the Transformation Zone

Loop Of Henle

A U-shaped part of each kidney's tiny filtering tube. It helps the kidney conserve water and control the concentration of urine by allowing water and salts to move differently along its two limbs.

Loose Bodies

Free fragments of cartilage, bone, or other tissue within a joint or body cavity that may cause pain, catching, or locking.

Loose Body

A free-floating intra-articular fragment of bone, calcified hyaline cartilage, or fibrous tissue within a synovial joint space ('joint mouse'), arising from osteochondritis dissecans, osteoarthritis, or trauma, capable of causing abrupt painful mechanical joint locking.

Alternate Names:
Joint Mouse; Intra-Articular Loose Fragment

Loperamide

Loperamide is a medicine that slows intestinal movement and reduces diarrhea. It may be unsafe in bloody or fever-related diarrhea, and excessive doses can cause severe abnormal heart rhythms.

Loperamide Hydrochloride

Loperamide hydrochloride is an antidiarrheal medicine that slows movement through the intestine; excessive doses can cause dangerous heart rhythms.

Lopinavir

Lopinavir is an HIV protease inhibitor used with ritonavir in antiretroviral treatment; drug interactions are common.

Loratadine

An antihistamine used to relieve sneezing, runny nose, itchy or watery eyes, and hives. It usually causes less drowsiness than older antihistamines, but sleepiness, headache, or dry mouth can still occur.

Lorazepam

Lorazepam is a benzodiazepine used short term for severe anxiety, seizures, or sedation; it can cause

drowsiness, dependence, and breathing suppression.

Lordosis

The inward curve of the neck or lower back. A curve that is unusually pronounced may be related to posture, pregnancy, muscle imbalance, spinal changes, or another condition and may cause back discomfort.

Losartan

Losartan is an angiotensin-receptor blocker used for high blood pressure, some kidney disease, and heart failure; it can raise potassium levels.

Losartan Potassium

Losartan potassium is the salt form of losartan, an angiotensin-receptor blocker used to lower blood pressure and protect selected patients with kidney or heart disease.

Loss Of Appetite

Reduced desire to eat. It may result from illness, medicines, mood disorders, pain, or other causes.

Loss of Bladder Control

Alternate name; see *Urinary Incontinence*.

Loss Of Consciousness

A temporary loss of awareness and responsiveness. It may result from fainting, seizure, head injury, low blood sugar, intoxication, or other serious conditions; unexplained, prolonged, or injury-associated episodes may indicate significant disease.

Loss-Of-Function Mutation

A genetic change that reduces or abolishes the normal activity or production of a gene product; its clinical effect depends on the gene, variant, and inheritance pattern.

Loss-Of-Function Variant

A genetic variant that reduces or abolishes the normal activity of the encoded gene product. Disease risk depends on the gene, inheritance pattern, residual function, and whether one or both copies are affected.

Loss Of Heterozygosity

Loss of heterozygosity is loss of one of two different versions of a gene in a cell, a change that can contribute to cancer when a tumor-suppressor gene is affected.

Loss of Smell

Partial or complete inability to detect odors, commonly caused by nasal obstruction, infection, inflammation, head injury, neurologic disease, or certain medicines.

Loteprednol Etabonate

Loteprednol etabonate is a corticosteroid eye medicine used for eye inflammation; prolonged use can raise eye pressure and increase infection risk.

Lou Gehrig Disease

Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis, a progressive neurodegenerative disease affecting upper and lower motor neurons and causing weakness, muscle wasting, and eventual respiratory impairment.

Lou Gehrig's Disease

Alternate name; see *Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis*.

Louse

Singular form; see *Lice*.

Lovastatin

Lovastatin is a statin medicine that lowers LDL cholesterol and reduces cardiovascular risk; muscle injury and liver effects are uncommon but important risks.

Low Back Pain

Pain or discomfort in the lower back, commonly caused by muscle or ligament strain, disc disease, arthritis, or spinal nerve irritation. Weakness, numbness, new bladder or bowel problems, fever, major trauma, or unexplained weight loss can indicate serious spinal or systemic disease.

Alternate Names:

Lumbago; LBP

Low Back Pain Deciding About MRI

The decision to obtain lumbar MRI depends on red flags, neurologic findings, duration, treatment response, and whether imaging would change management; routine early imaging is not useful for uncomplicated low back pain.

Low Back Pain Exercises

Movements used to improve strength, flexibility, or function in people with low back pain. The choice and intensity depend on the cause of the pain and the person's symptoms.

Low Birth Weight

A birth weight below 2,500 grams (about 5 pounds 8 ounces), whether caused by being born early, slower growth before birth, or both. Lower weights carry greater risks, including temperature instability, feeding difficulty, infection, and breathing problems.

Low Blood Oxygen

An abnormally low oxygen level in arterial blood, usually related to lung disease, impaired breathing, circulation problems, or reduced oxygen availability.

Low Blood Potassium

Low blood potassium, or hypokalemia, can cause weakness, cramps, constipation, abnormal heart rhythms, or paralysis and may result from losses, medicines, or hormonal disease.

Low Blood Pressure

Blood pressure that is lower than expected for a person. Some people have low readings without symptoms; others may have dizziness, fainting, confusion, or signs that organs are not receiving enough blood. A single cutoff does not define low blood pressure for everyone.

Alternate Names:
Hypotension

Low Blood Pressure Causes

Alternate name; see *Hypotension*.

Low Blood Sodium

Low blood sodium, or hyponatremia, reflects excess water relative to sodium and can cause headache, confusion, seizures, or coma when severe or rapidly developing.

Low Blood Sugar

Low blood sugar, or hypoglycemia, occurs when circulating glucose is insufficient for normal brain and body function, causing sweating, tremor, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Low Body Temperature

Alternate name; see *Hypothermia*.

Low-Calorie Diet

An eating plan that provides less energy than a person usually uses, often to support weight loss or a medical goal. Nutritional adequacy depends on protein, vitamins, minerals, fluids, and fiber intake.

Alternate Names:
Calorie-Restricted Diet

Low-Density Lipoprotein

A particle that carries cholesterol through the blood. Too much LDL cholesterol can collect in artery walls, forming fatty deposits that narrow arteries and increase the risk of heart attack and stroke.

Low-Dose Aspirin Therapy

Regular small-dose aspirin used for selected cardiovascular or obstetric indications. It can cause bleeding, and the balance of benefit and risk varies among people, especially in primary prevention.

Low-Dose CT Scan

A CT scan performed with less radiation than a standard scan. It is used for purposes such as lung-cancer screening or follow-up of lung nodules, but abnormal findings may require additional tests.

Lower Airway Obstruction

Narrowing or blockage of the breathing tubes inside the lungs. Asthma, chronic lung disease, infection, swelling, or a foreign object may cause wheezing,

cough, breathlessness, or reduced airflow.

Lower Esophageal Ring

A thin ring of tissue near the junction of the esophagus and stomach, often called a Schatzki ring. It can narrow the esophagus and cause intermittent difficulty swallowing solid food or food becoming stuck.

Lower Esophageal Sphincter

A ring of muscle where the esophagus joins the stomach. It opens during swallowing and normally closes afterward to limit backward flow of stomach contents and acid.

Alternate Names:
LES

Lower Extremity

The lower extremity is the hip, thigh, knee, leg, ankle, and foot, including their bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, and skin.

Lower Extremity Amputation Dressing Care

Care of the amputation wound and residual limb, including dressing selection, wound monitoring, swelling management, and limb shaping. The approach depends on the amputation, healing, and rehabilitation plan.

Alternate Names:
Stump Dressing Change; Residual Limb Care; Amputation Wound Management

Lower Extremity Arterial Bypass

An operation that routes blood around a blocked leg artery using a vein or synthetic graft. The bypass may connect arteries at the thigh, knee, or lower leg, depending on the blockage.

Alternate Names:
Leg Arterial Bypass; Peripheral Arterial Bypass

Lower Extremity Peripheral Artery Disease

Narrowing or blockage of arteries supplying the legs, usually from atherosclerosis. It may cause pain while walking, pain at rest, slow-healing sores, or limb-threatening loss of blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Lower Extremity PAD; Leg Arteriosclerosis Obliterans

Lower Extremity Venogram

Contrast imaging of the veins of a leg, used selectively to evaluate suspected deep-vein thrombosis or venous obstruction when noninvasive imaging is inadequate.

Lower Extremity Venous Doppler

An ultrasound test of the leg veins that shows blood flow and whether the veins compress normally. It is commonly used to look for a deep-vein blood clot.

Lower Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Bleeding that originates in the lower digestive tract, including the small intestine, colon, rectum, or anus. It most often appears as bright red or dark maroon blood passed with bowel movements, or as hidden blood leading to anemia; common causes include diverticular bleeding, hemorrhoids, polyps, colon cancer, and colitis. Heavy bleeding, dizziness, or fainting may occur.

Alternate Names:
Lower GI bleeding; LGIB; Lower gastrointestinal hemorrhage.

Lower Leg

The part of the limb between the knee and ankle, containing the tibia, fibula, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

Lower Motor Neuron Syndrome

A pattern of weakness caused by damage to nerves that carry movement signals from the spinal cord or brainstem to muscles. It may cause muscle wasting, twitching, low muscle tone, and reduced reflexes.

Lower Segment Cesarean Section

Alternate name; see *Cesarean Section*.

Alternate Names:
LSCS; Lower Segment Cesarian Section

Lower Urinary Tract Symptoms

Problems with storing or passing urine, including urgency, frequency, nighttime urination, weak stream, straining, leakage, or a feeling of incomplete emptying. Causes include infection, prostate enlargement, bladder disorders, nerve disease, medicines, and blockage.

Lowe's Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder, also called oculocerebrorenal syndrome, that mainly affects the eyes, brain, and kidneys. Features may include congenital cataracts, developmental difficulties, low muscle tone, and kidney-related loss of minerals.

Low Eye Tension

Alternate name; see *Ocular Hypotony*.

Low-Fiber Diet

An eating plan that limits foods such as whole grains, nuts, seeds, raw vegetables, and fruit skins. It may temporarily reduce stool volume for selected bowel problems or medical procedures.

Low-Flow Low-Gradient Aortic Stenosis

A severe narrowing of the aortic valve in which less blood moves through the valve and the pressure difference is lower than expected. Echocardiography and other tests help confirm severity.

Alternate Names:
LF-LG Aortic Stenosis

Low-Flow Priapism

Alternate name; see *Priapism*.

Low FODMAP Diet

A temporary eating plan that limits certain poorly absorbed carbohydrates that can cause gas, bloating, pain, or diarrhea in some people with irritable bowel syndrome. Foods are gradually reintroduced with dietitian guidance to identify personal triggers.

Low Grade

Describes a disease or tumor that appears less aggressive or more slowly developing than higher-grade forms. The exact meaning and outlook depend on the specific disease and test used.

Low-Grade Appendiceal Mucinous Neoplasm

A mucin-producing appendiceal neoplasm with low-grade cytologic atypia that may dilate the appendix and rupture, disseminating mucin into the peritoneum as pseudomyxoma peritonei.

Low-Grade Astrocytoma

A usually slow-growing glioma composed of astrocytic cells, often arising in the brain or spinal cord. Symptoms depend on location and may include seizures, headache, weakness, or visual change; molecular classification and grade guide prognosis and care.

Low-Grade Central Osteosarcoma

A rare low-grade malignant osteogenic tumor arising within the medullary cavity of bone. It may resemble fibrous dysplasia or a benign fibro-osseous lesion; treatment usually involves complete oncologic excision.

Low-Grade Endometrial Stromal Sarcoma

A malignant uterine stromal tumor resembling proliferative-phase endometrial stroma, characterized by infiltrative myometrial or vascular growth and often driven by characteristic gene fusions.

Low HDL Cholesterol (Hypoalphalipoproteinemia)

A low concentration of high-density lipoprotein cholesterol, associated with metabolic disease, obesity, smoking, genetic disorders, or other causes. Cardiovascular risk is assessed from the entire lipid profile and clinical context rather than HDL alone.

Low Hemoglobin Count

A hemoglobin level below the expected range, often indicating anemia from blood loss, reduced production, nutritional deficiency, inflammation, or increased destruction of red blood cells.

Low LDL Cholesterol

(Hypobetalipoproteinemia)

An unusually low concentration of low-density lipoprotein cholesterol, often related to inherited apolipoprotein B disorders, other genetic traits, malabsorption, illness, or lipid-lowering treatment. The cause and associated liver or nutritional findings guide evaluation.

Low Molecular Weight Heparin

Alternate spelling; see *Low-Molecular-Weight Heparin*.

Low-Molecular-Weight Heparin

A group of blood-thinning medicines, including enoxaparin and dalteparin, derived from heparin. They prevent or treat blood clots and can cause bleeding or, rarely, a low platelet count.

Alternate Names:
LMWH

Low Nasal Bridge

A low nasal bridge is reduced height of the nasal root and may be a normal familial feature or part of a congenital, genetic, or developmental syndrome.

Low Neutrophil Count

Alternate name; see *Neutropenia*.

Lown-Ganong-Levine Syndrome

A historical term for a short PR interval with a normal-width QRS complex, sometimes seen in people with episodes of rapid heartbeat. It is not considered a distinct syndrome with one established electrical pathway; associated arrhythmias and causes vary.

Alternate Names:
LGL Syndrome; Accelerated AV Conduction Syndrome

Low-Phosphorus Diet

A dietary pattern limiting phosphorus intake for selected patients with chronic kidney disease or persistent hyperphosphatemia. It emphasizes avoidance of phosphate additives while maintaining adequate protein and overall nutritional status.

Low Platelet Count

Alternate name; see *Thrombocytopenia*.

Low Potassium

An abnormally low potassium level in the blood, which can cause weakness, cramps, abnormal heart rhythms, or paralysis and may result from losses, medicines, or hormonal disorders.

Low-Potassium Diet

A dietary pattern limiting potassium intake when clinically indicated, usually for hyperkalemia or advanced kidney disease. The degree of restriction varies with potassium levels and kidney function; unnecessary restriction can reduce diet quality and cause inadequate intake of fruits and vegetables.

Low Potassium Syndrome

Alternate name for hypokalemia, an abnormally low blood potassium level that can cause weakness, cramps, paralysis, or dangerous heart-rhythm changes; see *Hypokalemia*.

Low-Residue Diet

A short-term diet limiting dietary fiber and foods that leave substantial undigested material in the bowel. It may be used in selected gastrointestinal conditions or around certain procedures but is not a universal treatment for inflammatory bowel disease.

Low-Salt Diet

A low-salt diet limits sodium intake and may help control blood pressure or fluid retention in conditions such as heart failure and kidney disease.

Low-Set Ear

An ear positioned lower on the side of the head than expected relative to facial landmarks; it may be an isolated variation or a feature of a genetic or developmental condition.

Low-Set Ears And Pinna Abnormalities

Differences in the position, size, shape, or folds of the external ear, including ears positioned lower than usual. They may occur alone or with a congenital

syndrome and can occur alongside hearing or other physical differences.

Low Sperm Count

A semen condition in which sperm concentration is below the expected reference range. It may reduce the chance of pregnancy, but fertility also depends on sperm movement, shape, ejaculation, and the partner's health.

Low T

Alternate name; see *Low Testosterone*.

Low-Tension Glaucoma

Alternate name; see *Normal-Tension Glaucoma*.

Low Testosterone

A condition in which a person has symptoms of testosterone deficiency and repeatedly low morning testosterone levels. Causes may involve the testes, ovaries, pituitary gland, medicines, obesity, or another illness.

Alternate Names:
Male Hypogonadism; Testosterone Deficiency

Low Vision

Visual impairment that cannot be fully corrected with spectacles, contact lenses, medication, or surgery, impairing daily activities. Managed with low-vision aids (magnifiers, telescopes, adaptive devices), lighting, and occupational therapy.

Low White Blood Cell Count

A reduced number of white blood cells, which can increase susceptibility to infection and may result from medicines, infection, autoimmune disease, nutritional deficiency, or bone marrow disorders.

Low White Cell Count in Cancer

A reduced number of infection-fighting blood cells in a person with cancer or receiving cancer treatment. The risk of serious infection depends on which cells are low and how severely they are reduced.

Lozenges

Solid medicinal preparations that dissolve slowly in the mouth, usually to provide local treatment for the throat or oral cavity.

LRINEC Score

A blood-test score that estimates the chance of a serious soft-tissue infection such as necrotizing fasciitis. It uses inflammation, blood count, sodium, kidney, and blood-sugar results. The score cannot by itself confirm or exclude the infection; severe pain, rapid swelling, or serious illness may occur.

Alternate Names:
Laboratory Risk Indicator for Necrotizing Fasciitis; LRINEC

LSD

Lysergic acid diethylamide is a potent hallucinogen that can cause altered perception, visual hallucinations, autonomic effects, and unpredictable changes in mood and behavior.

LSD Substance Use

LSD is a potent hallucinogen that alters perception, mood, and thought and can cause panic, accidents, persistent perceptual symptoms, or psychosis in susceptible people.

LSD Toxicity

Hallucinogen poisoning causing perceptual distortion, anxiety, panic, agitation, hallucinations, mydriasis, tachycardia, hypertension, and impaired judgment. Severe agitation, hyperthermia, seizures, trauma, or persistent psychosis can occur; use a calm environment, supportive care, and benzodiazepines when clinically indicated.

L-theanine

An amino acid found mainly in tea leaves. It may influence relaxation and alertness, but supplements can interact with medicines and are not proven treatments for disease.

Lubiprostone

Lubiprostone activates intestinal chloride channels

and is used for selected forms of chronic constipation and irritable bowel syndrome with constipation.

Lubricant

A substance that reduces friction between surfaces; medical lubricants are used on skin, mucosa, instruments, or devices, with formulations varying by tissue compatibility and intended use.

Lucilia

A genus of blowflies; some species can cause wound myiasis, while sterile larvae have occasionally been used in maggot debridement.

Ludwig Angina

A fast-spreading infection under the tongue and jaw, often starting from an infected lower tooth. It can cause swelling that pushes the tongue upward and makes swallowing or breathing difficult.

Ludwig's Angina

Alternate name; see *Ludwig Angina*.

Lugano Classification

A system used to describe how far Hodgkin or non-Hodgkin lymphoma has spread and how it responds to treatment. It combines examination, blood tests, and imaging, often PET with CT. Stages range from disease in one area to widespread disease; the results help guide treatment and follow-up.

Lugol's Iodine

An aqueous solution of iodine and potassium iodide used as an antiseptic, in selected thyroid treatments, and in some laboratory procedures.

Lugol's Solution

Lugol's solution is a mixture of iodine and potassium iodide used in selected laboratory, diagnostic, and medical applications; it can irritate tissue and affect thyroid function.

Lumbago

A non-specific term for low back pain, typically referring to acute or chronic pain in the lumbar region (between the lower ribs and the gluteal folds). Lumbago is a symptom, not a diagnosis.

Lumbar

Relating to the lower back or its five vertebrae (L1–L5), which lie between the thoracic spine and sacrum. The lumbar region also includes the discs, joints, muscles, and nerves around these vertebrae. The lumbar vertebrae support much of the upper body's weight.

Lumbar Disc Herniation

Protrusion or extrusion of lumbar disc material through the annulus fibrosus, which may irritate or compress a nerve root and cause back or leg pain. Symptoms, examination findings, and imaging determine its significance and treatment.

Lumbar Disk Replacement

Surgical replacement of a worn or herniated intervertebral disc in the lower back with an artificial prosthetic disc to relieve nerve pain while preserving spinal flexibility.

Alternate Names:
Artificial Disc Replacement; Total Disc Arthroplasty; Lumbar Arthroplasty

Lumbar Hernia

A rare abdominal-wall hernia in which tissue, usually fat or bowel, protrudes through a weak area in the lower back or flank. It may be present from birth or develop after surgery or injury and can cause a bulge or discomfort.

Alternate Names:
Flank Hernia; Dorsal Hernia

Lumbar Lordosis

The normal inward curve of the lower spine. An unusually pronounced or reduced curve may be related to posture, pregnancy, muscle imbalance, spinal changes, or another condition.

Alternate Names:
Lumbar Inward Curvature

Lumbar Lordosis Lower Spine

Lumbar lordosis is the normal inward curve of the lower spine; excessive or reduced curvature may be associated with posture, muscle imbalance, hip disease, vertebral deformity, or pain. Examination and imaging are guided by symptoms rather than appearance alone.

Lumbar MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the lumbar spine used to evaluate vertebrae, discs, spinal canal, nerve roots, marrow, and soft tissues in conditions such as radiculopathy or spinal stenosis.

Lumbar Pain

Pain arising in the lower back, often from muscles, joints, discs, nerves, or other spinal or nonspinal causes; see *Low Back Pain*.

Lumbar Plexus

The lumbar plexus is a network of nerves from the upper lumbar spinal roots that supplies the lower abdomen, pelvis, and parts of the thigh and leg.

Lumbar Puncture

A procedure in which a needle is inserted between vertebrae in the lower back into the space containing cerebrospinal fluid around the brain and spinal cord. It is used to collect fluid for testing or to measure its pressure. It can also deliver medicines into this space. Fluid testing can help diagnose infections, bleeding, inflammation, and some cancers. Possible complications include headache, temporary back discomfort, bleeding, or infection.

Alternate Names:
LP; Spinal Tap

Lumbar Puncture Opening Pressure

The cerebrospinal fluid pressure measured with a manometer during lumbar puncture, ideally with the patient relaxed in the lateral decubitus position. A typical adult reference range is about 6 to 25 cm H2O; interpretation depends on measurement technique and clinical context.

Lumbar Radiculopathy

Irritation or pressure on a nerve leaving the lower spine, causing pain that travels into the buttock or leg. It may also cause numbness, tingling, or weakness and is often called sciatica.

Lumbar Region

The lumbar region is the lower part of the back between the ribs and pelvis, containing the five lumbar vertebrae.

Lumbar Spinal Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Lumbar Stenosis*.

Lumbar Spine

The lower part of the backbone between the ribs and pelvis, usually made of five vertebrae. It bears much of the body's weight and contains nerves supplying the legs; discs, joints, or nerves there may cause lower-back pain or sciatica.

Alternate Names:
L-Spine; Lower Vertebral Column

Lumbar Spine CT Scan

Computed tomography of the lumbar spine that provides detailed images of vertebral bone and alignment and is particularly useful for detecting fractures or other bony abnormalities.

Lumbar Spondylosis

Alternate name; see *Spondylosis*.

Lumbar Stenosis

A narrowing of the spinal canal or nerve openings in the lower back (lumbar spine), most often caused by age-related wear and tear, arthritis, bone spurs, and thickened ligaments. The narrowed space pinches and compresses the nerves traveling down to the legs, causing aching pain, cramping, numbness, or weakness in the buttocks, thighs, or calves that typically worsens when walking or standing and eases when sitting or bending forward.

Alternate Names:
LSS; Lumbar Spinal Stenosis

Lumbar Vertebrae

The five large bones of the lower spine between the ribs and pelvis. They bear much of the body's weight, allow bending, protect spinal nerves, and can be affected by fractures, arthritis, or disc problems.

Lumbosacral Radiculopathy

Pain, sensory change, or weakness caused by irritation or compression of a nerve root in the lower lumbar or sacral spine. Symptoms often radiate from the back or buttock into the leg in a dermatomal pattern.

Lumbosacral Region

The lumbosacral region is the junction between the lower lumbar spine and the sacrum at the back of the pelvis.

Lumbosacral Spine CT

Computed tomography of the lower spine and sacrum using x-rays and computer reconstruction to evaluate fractures, bone lesions, alignment, and selected causes of nerve compression.

Lumbosacral Spine X-Ray

Plain radiographic imaging of the lumbar spine and sacrum used to evaluate alignment, fractures, degenerative changes, deformity, and some bone lesions.

Lumbricals

Small hand or foot muscles arising from tendons of the flexor digitorum profundus or flexor digitorum longus and assisting flexion-extension coordination.

Lumen

The inner space of a hollow organ, vessel, or tube.

Luminescence

Luminescence is emission of light from a substance through a process other than high-temperature incandescence, such as fluorescence or chemiluminescence.

Luminescence Type

Luminescence type identifies the mechanism by which a material emits light, such as fluorescence, phosphorescence, bioluminescence, or chemiluminescence.

Lumpectomy

Breast-conserving surgery that removes a cancer or other abnormal area with a small margin of nearby tissue. Depending on the diagnosis and recurrence risk, subsequent treatment can include radiation or other cancer therapy.

Lump in Right Iliac Fossa

A lump in the lower-right part of the abdomen. Causes include an enlarged appendix or nearby bowel, a hernia, swollen lymph nodes, or a growth. Examination and tests help find the cause.

Lump In The Abdomen

An abdominal lump may be a hernia, enlarged organ, cyst, stool, inflammation, or tumor; pain, vomiting, fever, growth, or a pulsatile mass can signal a serious underlying cause.

Lumpy Jaw

A chronic granulomatous infection of the jaw, usually cervicofacial actinomycosis, causing swelling and sinus formation.

Lunate

A small crescent-shaped bone in the center of the wrist. It helps the wrist move and can be injured by falls; loss of its blood supply can cause Kienböck disease and bone collapse.

Lunate Bone

A crescent-shaped carpal bone situated in the center of the proximal carpal row between the scaphoid and triquetrum, articulating with the distal radius; vulnerable to avascular necrosis (Kienbock disease) and anterior dislocation into the carpal tunnel.

Lung

One of the two breathing organs in the chest. The lungs take oxygen into the blood and remove carbon dioxide. The right lung has three sections, and the

left has two to leave room for the heart.

Lung Abscess

A pocket of infection and pus that forms inside damaged lung tissue, often after inhaling stomach contents or because of bacteria. It may cause fever, cough, foul-smelling sputum, chest pain, and breathlessness.

Lung Anatomy

Alternate name; see *Lungs*.

Lung Cancer

Cancer that begins in the lungs or airways. The main types are small-cell and non-small-cell cancer. Smoking is the leading risk factor, but radon, asbestos, air pollution, inherited risk, and other exposures can also contribute. Early disease may cause no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Bronchogenic Carcinoma

Lung Capacity

The amount of air the lungs can hold or move, measured with breathing tests such as spirometry and lung-volume testing. Results help assess conditions including asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, and restrictive lung disease.

Lung Carcinoid Tumors

Neuroendocrine tumors arising in the lung, ranging from typical slow-growing tumors to atypical tumors with greater malignant potential; see *Carcinoid Tumor*.

Lung Collapse

An informal phrase for loss of lung expansion. It may refer to atelectasis, in which part of the lung loses air, or pneumothorax, in which air around the lung compresses it. Use the more specific term when the cause is known.

Lung Compliance

How easily the lungs stretch when a person breathes in. Stiff lungs require more effort, while overly flexible lungs may not spring back well, as can occur in emphysema.

Lung Cyst

A lung cyst is a round air- or fluid-containing space in lung tissue, caused by developmental disease, infection, emphysema, inflammation, or another disorder.

Lung Development

Lung development is embryonic and postnatal formation and maturation of airways, alveoli, blood vessels, and gas-exchange capacity.

Lung Diffusion Testing

A breathing test that measures how well a gas, usually a small amount of carbon monoxide, passes from the lung air sacs into the blood. It helps assess diseases such as emphysema, lung scarring, or disorders of the lung blood vessels.

Lung Disease

Lung disease includes disorders affecting the breathing tubes, air sacs, lung tissue, covering, blood vessels, or chest wall. These conditions may cause cough, breathlessness, chest discomfort, wheezing, or low oxygen.

Lung Disease/Respiratory Problems

Disorders affecting the airways, lung tissue, pleura, pulmonary blood vessels, or breathing control that may cause cough, shortness of breath, wheezing, chest discomfort, or low oxygen; see *Lung Disease*.

Lung Diseases

Alternate name; see *Lung Disease*.

Lung Fibroma

A usually noncancerous growth made of fibrous tissue in or near the lung. It often causes no symptoms and is found on imaging; appearance, growth, and location determine whether further imaging or biopsy is used.

Lung Fluke

A parasitic flatworm, usually of the Paragonimus group, acquired by eating undercooked freshwater crustaceans. Infection may cause chronic cough, chest pain, blood in sputum, or lung lesions and can rarely affect the brain.

Lung Function Tests

Physiologic tests that measure aspects of breathing, including airflow, lung volumes, and gas transfer, to assess respiratory function.

Lung Herniation

Protrusion of lung tissue through a weak or torn area of the chest wall, usually after chest trauma or surgery. It may appear as a bulge that enlarges with coughing and can cause pain or breathing difficulty.

Lung Injury

Damage to lung tissue or the pulmonary circulation caused by trauma, infection, inhaled substances, inflammation, aspiration, oxygen toxicity, or other disease.

Lung Lavage

A procedure in which doctors wash parts of the airways or lungs with sterile fluid and then remove it. It may clear certain material from the lungs or collect a sample for testing.

Lung Metastases

Lung metastases are cancer deposits that have spread to the lungs from another primary tumor and may cause cough, breathlessness, chest pain, or no symptoms.

Lung Biopsy

The removal of a sample of lung tissue using a needle, bronchoscope, or surgical incision to diagnose pulmonary infiltrates, masses, or interstitial lung disease; see *Biopsy Lung*, *Lung Needle Biopsy*, and *Open Lung Biopsy*.

Lung Needle Biopsy

CT- or ultrasound-guided percutaneous sampling of a lung or pleural lesion to evaluate selected masses, infection, or diffuse disease. Pneumothorax and pulmonary hemorrhage are important complications.

Lung Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the lung or airways that may be noncancerous or cancerous. It may cause cough, blood in sputum, chest pain, breathlessness, or no symptoms; imaging and sometimes tissue sampling determine its nature.

Lung Nocardiosis

Lung infection caused by Nocardia bacteria, usually in people with weakened immunity. It can cause cough, fever, chest pain, or nodules and may spread to the brain or other organs; see *Nocardiosis*.

Lung Nodule

A rounded, usually well-defined opacity in the lung measuring up to 3 cm on imaging. It may be benign, infectious, inflammatory, or an early manifestation of lung cancer; follow-up often uses interval imaging.

Lung PET Scan

Positron-emission tomography, often combined with computed tomography, using a radiotracer to assess metabolic activity in lung nodules, cancer, infection, or inflammation.

Lung Plethysmography

A breathing test performed in a sealed room to measure how much air the lungs hold, including air that cannot be breathed out, and how much resistance the airways provide.

Lung Problems And Volcanic Smog

Volcanic smog contains gases and fine particles that irritate eyes and airways and can worsen asthma or lung disease; limiting exposure and following public-health advice reduce harm.

Lung Protective Ventilation

A ventilator approach that uses gentle breath sizes and carefully controlled pressures to reduce further lung injury. It is commonly used in acute respiratory

distress, with settings adjusted to oxygen levels, blood gases, and the person's condition.

Lung Resection

Surgery to remove a portion or all of a lung, usually to treat cancer or another localized disease. The amount removed may range from a small wedge or segment to a lobe or an entire lung, depending on the disease and the person's lung function.

Lungs

The paired respiratory organs in the chest that exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide between air and blood; they also contribute to acid–base regulation.

Lungs Design And Purpose

Alternate name; see *Lungs*.

Lung Surgery

An operation on the lungs or nearby structures to remove or sample tissue, repair injury, or improve breathing. The procedure depends on the disease and may involve lung resection; bleeding, infection, air leakage, and breathing problems are possible.

Lung Transplant

Surgery to replace one or both severely diseased lungs with donor lungs. It may be considered for advanced lung failure from conditions such as emphysema, lung scarring, cystic fibrosis, or pulmonary hypertension and requires lifelong immune-suppressing medicines.

Lung Transplantation

Alternate name; see *Lung Transplant*.

Lung Volume Reduction Surgery

An operation that removes the most damaged, overinflated parts of the lungs in carefully selected people with severe emphysema. This gives healthier lung tissue and the diaphragm more room to work, which may improve breathing and activity. It has important risks, including air leakage, infection, and respiratory failure.

Alternate Names:
LVRS; Reduction Pneumoplasty; Bilateral Lung Volume Reduction

Lunula

The pale crescent-shaped area at the base of a fingernail or toenail. It is the visible front part of the nail-forming region, although its size and visibility vary normally.

Lupus

A group of autoimmune diseases in which the immune system attacks the body's own tissues. Systemic lupus erythematosus is one form and may affect the skin, joints, kidneys, blood cells, nervous system, and other organs.

Lupus Anticoagulant

An antiphospholipid autoantibody directed against phospholipid-protein complexes that paradoxically prolongs in vitro phospholipid-dependent coagulation tests (such as the dilute Russell viper venom time or aPTT) while promoting a potent in vivo hypercoagulable state with arterial and venous thrombosis.

Alternate Names:
LA; LAC

Lupus Arthritis

Joint pain or inflammation associated with systemic lupus erythematosus. It commonly affects multiple joints and is considered alongside other lupus manifestations and possible overlapping disease.

Lupus Band Test

A skin-biopsy test that looks for immune proteins along the junction between the skin's layers. The pattern may support lupus; its significance varies with symptoms and other test results.

Alternate Names:
LBT; Dermoepidermal Junction Immunofluorescence

Lupus Erythematosus

An umbrella term for autoimmune disorders that can affect the skin alone or multiple organs. Ma-

jor forms include cutaneous lupus erythematosus, which mainly affects the skin, and systemic lupus erythematosus, which can affect the joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, lungs, or heart.

Lupus Miliaris Disseminatus Faciei

A chronic granulomatous eruption of numerous red-brown or skin-colored papules, usually around the eyelids and central face. It may heal with small depressed scars; diagnosis often requires biopsy to distinguish it from acne, rosacea, sarcoidosis, and other granulomatous disorders.

Lupus Nephritis

An inflammation of the kidneys that occurs as a serious complication of systemic lupus erythematosus (lupus), an autoimmune disease. In lupus nephritis, the body's immune system produces abnormal antibodies that attack healthy kidney filtering units (glomeruli), causing swelling, inflammation, and potential kidney damage. It often develops quietly without early symptoms, but can lead to foamy or dark urine, swelling in the legs, ankles, and face, and high blood pressure.

Lupus Panniculitis

A chronic inflammatory form of cutaneous lupus affecting subcutaneous fat, producing firm deep nodules that may heal with lipoatrophy, scarring, or overlying discoid changes.

Lupus Pernio

Persistent red-purple or blue-purple swelling and discoloration of the nose, cheeks, lips, ears, or fingers, usually associated with sarcoidosis. It often indicates longer-lasting disease and may cause scarring or cosmetic changes.

Lupus Vulgaris

A long-lasting form of tuberculosis affecting the skin. It usually causes slowly enlarging reddish-brown patches or plaques that may scar and is treated with a combination of tuberculosis medicines.

Luteal Cell

A cell in the ovarian corpus luteum that produces progesterone after ovulation and supports the uterine lining.

Luteal Phase Defect

A term used when the part of the menstrual cycle after ovulation may not provide enough progesterone or enough time for the uterine lining to support pregnancy. The diagnosis is uncertain and cannot be determined from cycle length alone.

Alternate Names:
Luteal Phase Deficiency; LPD

Lutein

A yellow plant pigment found in leafy green vegetables and concentrated in the retina. Along with related pigments, it helps filter blue light and may protect eye tissues from oxidative damage.

Luteinization

Luteinization is the transformation of an ovarian follicle after ovulation into a corpus luteum that produces progesterone.

Luteinized Follicle Cyst

A usually harmless ovarian cyst that develops during pregnancy as hormone-sensitive ovarian tissue enlarges. It may be found by chance or as a pelvic mass and often settles after pregnancy.

Luteinizing Hormone

A hormone released by the pituitary gland. In people with ovaries, a mid-cycle rise triggers ovulation and supports hormone production; in people with testes, it stimulates testosterone production. Blood testing helps assess puberty, fertility, and pituitary or reproductive disorders.

Luteinizing Hormone Blood Test

A blood test measuring luteinizing hormone, which stimulates ovulation and ovarian hormone production in females and testosterone production in males; it helps evaluate puberty, fertility, and pituitary or gonadal disorders.

Luteinizing Hormone Deficiency

Inadequate luteinizing-hormone secretion from hypothalamic or pituitary disease, causing reduced gonadal steroid production, irregular or absent ovulation or menstruation, infertility, or delayed puberty.

Luteinizing Hormone-Releasing Hormone

An older name for gonadotropin-releasing hormone (GnRH), a hypothalamic hormone released in pulses that stimulates the anterior pituitary to secrete luteinizing hormone and follicle-stimulating hormone.

Lutembacher Syndrome

A rare congenital heart defect complex defined by the combination of an atrial septal defect (usually secundum type) and acquired or congenital mitral valve stenosis. The left-to-right atrial shunt partially decompresses the left atrium, reducing pulmonary venous congestion but markedly augmenting right ventricular volume overload and pulmonary arterial blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Lutembacher Disease

Luteolysis

Luteolysis is the breakdown of the corpus luteum, causing progesterone levels to fall when pregnancy has not occurred.

Luteoma

A luteoma is a usually benign ovarian mass of hormone-producing lutein cells, sometimes associated with pregnancy and androgen excess.

Luteoma Of Pregnancy

A benign, pregnancy-associated ovarian proliferation of luteinized stromal cells driven by hormonal stimulation. It may cause maternal or fetal androgen excess and usually regresses after delivery.

Luteotropic Hormone

A hormone that supports the corpus luteum. In humans, the term has historically referred to prolactin; its use can differ among species.

Lutetium-177

A radioactive form of lutetium that releases therapeutic radiation and a small amount of detectable radiation. Attached to a targeting molecule, it can deliver treatment to selected neuroendocrine or prostate cancer cells while limiting exposure to other tissues.

Luxation

Complete dislocation of a joint, where the bone ends lose normal contact. It can stretch or tear nearby ligaments, nerves, and blood vessels, causing severe pain, deformity, swelling, and inability to move.

LVAD

Left-ventricular assist device, an implanted pump helping the heart's main chamber circulate blood. It may support people with severe heart failure while awaiting transplant or as long-term treatment.

Alternate Names:
Left-Ventricular Assist Device

LVNC

Alternate name; see *Left Ventricular Noncompaction*.

LVRS

Alternate name; see *Lung Volume Reduction Surgery*.

Lyase

An enzyme that breaks or joins certain chemical bonds without adding water or using oxidation as the main step. Lyases participate in many processes that make or use energy in cells.

Lyme Arthritis

Joint inflammation caused by Lyme disease, often with swelling in a large joint such as the knee. It can appear weeks or months after infection and is evaluated and treated as part of Lyme disease.

Lyme Disease

A bacterial infection transmitted to humans through the bite of infected blacklegged ticks (deer ticks). The illness often begins with an expanding, circular red rash that frequently resembles a bullseye (extiterythema migrans) at the site of the tick bite, accompanied by flu-like symptoms such as fatigue, fever, headache, and muscle and joint aches. If not diagnosed and addressed early, the bacteria can spread, causing joint swelling (arthritis), facial muscle weakness (Bell palsy), heart palpitations, and nerve pain.

Alternate Names:
Lyme Borreliosis; Borrelia Burgdorferi Infection

Lyme Disease Blood Test

A blood test that looks for immune proteins made after infection with Lyme disease bacteria. Results depend on symptoms, tick exposure, and timing; early testing can be negative and a positive result does not always prove active infection.

Lyme Neuroborreliosis

Neurologic disease caused when Lyme bacteria spread to the nervous system. It can cause meningitis, cranial nerve palsy, or painful inflammation of nerve roots. Bannwarth syndrome is a form of Lyme neuroborreliosis, especially recognized in Europe, and is not a name for every neurologic Lyme infection.

Alternate Names:
Neurological Lyme Disease

Lymph

A clear fluid collected from body tissues and carried through lymph vessels. It transports immune cells and excess fluid to lymph nodes and eventually returns it to the bloodstream.

Lymphadenectomy

Surgical removal of a group of lymph nodes, usually for cancer staging or treatment. The site and extent depend on the disease and may include axillary, inguinal, cervical, or abdominal nodes.

Lymphadenitis

Inflammation or infection of one or more lymph nodes, causing swelling and sometimes tenderness, warmth, or pus. Causes include viruses, bacteria, cat-scratch disease, tuberculosis, and other disorders.

Lymphadenopathy

Enlargement of one or more lymph nodes, either localized to one region or generalized across two or more noncontiguous regions. It is a clinical finding rather than a diagnosis and may result from infection, inflammation, immune disease, medicines, or cancer.

Lymphangiectasia

Dilatation of lymphatic vessels that can cause clear or blood-tinged vesicles, swelling, or leakage of lymph through the skin or mucosa. It may be primary or follow surgery, radiation, inflammation, infection, or obstruction of lymphatic drainage.

Lymphangiectasis

Abnormal widening of lymph vessels. It may be present from birth or develop later and can cause swelling, leakage of lymph, loss of protein through the intestine, or fluid around the lungs.

Lymphangiogenesis

Formation of new lymph vessels from existing vessels. This can help repair tissue and drain fluid, but it may also contribute to chronic swelling, inflammation, or the spread of cancer.

Lymphangiogram

A lymphangiogram uses contrast imaging to show lymphatic vessels and nodes, helping evaluate obstruction, leakage, malformation, or spread of disease.

Lymphangiography

An imaging test that uses contrast dye to show lymphatic vessels and their flow. It can help find blocked vessels, leaks, or abnormal connections, although newer scans are often preferred.

Lymphangioleimyomatosis

Alternate spelling; see *Lymphangioleiomyomatosis*.

Lymphangioleiomyomatosis

A rare disease, usually affecting women, in which abnormal smooth-muscle-like cells grow in the lungs and lymphatic system and destroy lung tissue, forming many cysts. It can cause breathlessness, collapsed lung, or lymph-fluid buildup; kidney angiomyolipomas may also occur. It may be associated with tuberous sclerosis complex or occur on its own.

Lymphangioma

A noncancerous birth defect in which lymph vessels form abnormally and become enlarged. It usually appears in infancy or childhood as a soft swelling, often in the neck, armpit, or chest.

Lymphangiomatosis

A rare disorder in which abnormal lymph vessels grow in one or more organs. It may cause swelling, fluid buildup, bleeding, bone damage, or breathing problems, depending on the tissues involved.

Lymphangiomyoma

A rare, usually noncancerous growth made of smooth-muscle-like cells around lymph vessels. It is most often associated with lymphangioleiomyomatosis and may contribute to cysts or blockage of lymph flow.

Lymphangiosarcoma

A rare, fast-growing cancer arising from the lining of lymph vessels. It may develop in tissue with long-standing lymph swelling and can appear as a bruise-like, purple, or ulcerated skin lesion.

Lymphangitis

Inflammation and infection of lymphatic vessels, usually spreading from an infected skin wound or cellulitis; tender red streaks, fever, and enlarged regional lymph nodes may occur.

Lymphatic Basin

The group of lymph vessels and lymph nodes that drains a particular body area. Doctors use this drainage pattern to examine nearby nodes and assess possible spread of infection or cancer.

Lymphatic Capillary

The smallest type of lymphatic vessel. It begins in body tissues, collects extra tissue fluid, and carries it into larger lymphatic vessels.

Lymphatic Circulation

The movement of lymph from body tissues through lymphatic vessels and nodes back into the bloodstream.

Lymphatic Disease

Any disorder affecting lymph vessels, lymph nodes, or related organs. It may cause swelling, repeated infection, abnormal fluid collections, or cancer and may result from birth defects, injury, infection, inflammation, or tumor growth.

Lymphatic Drainage

The movement of lymph away from a body area through lymphatic vessels and lymph nodes.

Lymphatic Filariasis

A mosquito-borne infection caused by thread-like worms that live in lymph vessels. Repeated infection can block lymph flow and cause long-term swelling of the legs, arms, breasts, or genitals.

Lymphatic Malformation

A birth defect in which lymphatic vessels form abnormally. It may cause soft, fluid-filled spaces in the skin or deeper tissues.

Lymphatic Mapping

Imaging or tracer-guided identification of lymphatic vessels and lymph nodes that drain a body area. It helps plan surgery, locate a sentinel node, investigate lymphedema, or assess possible cancer spread.

Lymphatic Obstruction

Blocked or damaged lymph vessels or nodes that prevent normal fluid drainage. The affected area

may develop persistent swelling called lymphedema.

Lymphatic System

A network of lymph, lymphatic vessels, lymph nodes, and lymphoid organs and tissues, including the spleen, thymus, tonsils, and bone marrow. It returns excess tissue fluid to the bloodstream, transports absorbed dietary fats and fat-soluble nutrients, and supports immune-cell development, surveillance, and responses to infection.

Lymphatic Tissue

Lymphatic tissue contains immune cells and structures that filter lymph, trap antigens, and coordinate immune defense.

Lymphatic Trunk

A large lymphatic vessel formed by the joining of smaller lymphatic vessels. It drains a body region and empties into a lymphatic duct.

Lymphatic Valve

A flap inside a lymphatic vessel that helps keep lymph moving in one direction.

Lymphatic Vessel

A lymphatic vessel transports lymph from tissues through lymph nodes and eventually returns fluid to the bloodstream.

Lymphedema

Chronic swelling caused by a buildup of protein-rich lymph fluid when lymphatic vessels or lymph nodes cannot drain it normally. It most often affects an arm or leg, but may also involve the trunk, breast, face, or genitals. The affected area may feel heavy, tight, or uncomfortable and may develop inflammation, thickened skin, reduced movement, or repeated skin infections. Primary lymphedema results from abnormal lymphatic development or inherited changes; secondary lymphedema follows damage or blockage from causes such as surgery, radiation, cancer, infection, or injury.

Lymphedema Surgery

Procedures intended to reduce persistent lymph-fluid swelling or improve lymphatic drainage. Options include lymphovenous bypass, vascularized lymph-node transfer, liposuction for selected chronic tissue changes, and excision or debulking in advanced disease.

Lymph Leakage

Lymph leakage is escape of lymphatic fluid after injury, surgery, or obstruction and may cause swelling, fluid collections, or chylous drainage.

Lymph Node

A small, encapsulated, bean-shaped secondary lymphoid organ strategically positioned in serial arrays along the lymphatic vascular network to filter interstitial lymph fluid and orchestrate adaptive immune responses against tissue-derived antigens. Histologically enclosed by a dense fibrous capsule and organized into three distinct compartments: (1) The Cortex (containing outer B-cell-rich primary follicles and secondary follicles with active germinal centers where B cells undergo antigen-driven somatic hypermutation, affinity maturation, and class-switch recombination with the assistance of follicular dendritic cells and follicular helper T cells); (2) The Paracortex (the deep cortical zone populated predominantly by naive and memory CD4+ and CD8+ T lymphocytes and interdigitating dendritic cells, containing specialized high endothelial venules [HEVs] expressing addressins that facilitate lymphocyte homing from the bloodstream); and (3) The Medulla (composed of cellular medullary cords containing antibody-secreting plasma cells, macrophages, and B cells, separated by medullary lymphatic sinuses lined by phagocytic reticuloendothelial cells that drain into the single efferent lymphatic vessel at the hilum). Lymph enters via multiple afferent lymphatic vessels piercing the convex capsule, percolates through subcapsular and trabecular sinuses for microvascular antigen sampling, and exits at the concavity (hilum). Pathologic enlargement (lymphadenopathy) reflects immune stimulation (reactive hyperplasia), acute suppurative infection (lymphadenitis), granulomatous disease (sarcoidosis, tuberculosis), or primary/metastatic

malignancy (lymphoma, metastatic carcinoma).

Lymph Node Biopsy

Removal of part or all of a lymph node for microscopic and sometimes microbiologic or molecular examination to evaluate malignancy, infection, or inflammatory disease.

Lymph Node Cancer

Cancer involving lymph nodes, either lymphoma arising in lymphatic tissue or cancer spread from another organ; tissue examination and staging establish its type and extent.

Lymph Node Culture

Laboratory culture of lymph-node tissue or aspirate to identify bacteria, fungi, or mycobacteria causing lymphadenitis; culture is interpreted with histology and other tests.

Lymph Node Dissection

Surgery that removes one or more groups of lymph nodes to check for cancer or treat cancer spread. Removed tissue is examined in a laboratory, and the operation can cause swelling or numbness.

Lymph Node / Gland

A small immune organ along a lymph vessel that filters lymph and helps the body recognize infection, inflammation, or abnormal cells. Nodes are found in groups in the neck, armpits, chest, abdomen, and groin.

Lymph Nodes

Plural form; see *Lymph Node*.

Alternate Names:
Lymph Glands

Lymph Node Structure

A lymph node is a small, bean-shaped immune organ with a capsule, spaces that carry lymph, and areas rich in immune cells. It filters lymph and may enlarge during infection, inflammation, or cancer spread.

Lymphoblast

An immature cell that normally develops into a type of infection-fighting white blood cell. Large numbers of abnormal lymphoblasts can build up in the blood or bone marrow in acute lymphoblastic leukemia.

Lymphoblast Count

A lymphoblast count measures immature lymphoid cells in blood or bone marrow and may help evaluate or monitor acute lymphoblastic leukemia.

Lymphoblastic Lymphoma

An aggressive lymphoma of immature B- or T-cell precursors, closely related to acute lymphoblastic leukemia. It often presents with lymph-node, mediastinal, bone, skin, or marrow disease; immunophenotyping and marrow assessment help classify the extent.

Lymphocele

A lymphocele is a collection of lymphatic fluid caused by disruption or blockage of lymph vessels, often after surgery or transplantation.

Lymphocyte

A type of white blood cell that recognizes infections and abnormal cells and helps coordinate immune defense. The main types are B cells, which make antibodies; T cells, which direct or carry out cellular immune responses; and natural killer cells, which can destroy infected or abnormal cells.

Lymphocyte Activation

The process by which a lymphocyte recognizes a target and begins responding. Activated lymphocytes multiply and help coordinate antibody or cellular immune defense.

Lymphocyte Count

A lymphocyte count measures lymphocytes in the blood and can help assess infection, immune deficiency, inflammation, or blood disorders.

Lymphocyte Proliferation

Rapid multiplication of lymphocytes after immune stimulation. It helps build a response to infection, but abnormal or uncontrolled proliferation can occur in lymphoid cancers.

Lymphocytic

Relating to lymphocytes or containing an increased proportion of these white blood cells. A lymphocytic pattern may occur with viral infection, chronic inflammation, autoimmune disease, or certain cancers.

Lymphocytic Choriomeningitis

A viral infection caused by lymphocytic choriomeningitis virus, usually spread through contact with urine, droppings, or saliva from infected mice. It may cause a flu-like illness or, less often, meningitis; infection during pregnancy can harm the fetus.

Alternate Names:
LCMV Infection

Lymphocytic Colitis

A form of microscopic colitis causing long-lasting, watery diarrhea. The colon may look normal during examination, but a biopsy shows increased immune cells in its lining; medicines, autoimmune disease, or other factors may contribute.

Alternate Names:
IEL-Predominant Colitis

Lymphocytic Interstitial Pneumonia

A rare inflammatory lung disease in which immune cells collect in the tissue around the air sacs. It may cause cough, breathlessness, and abnormal scans and is associated with autoimmune disease or HIV.

Lymphocytic Leukemia

Lymphocytic leukemia is a blood cancer in which abnormal lymphoid cells multiply in the bone marrow, blood, lymph nodes, or other tissues.

Lymphocytic Mastitis

A noncancerous breast lump caused by inflammation and toughening of breast tissue. It is associated with diabetes or autoimmune disease and can look like breast cancer on examination or scans, so testing may be needed.

Lymphocytoma Cutis

Lymphocytoma cutis is a benign skin lymphoid proliferation presenting as red or violaceous plaques or nodules and sometimes associated with infection or immune stimulation.

Lymphocytopenia

An abnormally low number of lymphocytes, a type of white blood cell that helps fight infection. It may be temporary after illness or stress, or result from medicines, immune disorders, infections, poor marrow function, or inherited conditions. Infection risk varies with the severity, duration, and cause.

Lymphocytosis

An abnormally increased number or proportion of lymphocytes in the blood, often associated with viral infection, some bacterial infections, or lymphoproliferative disorders.

Lymphoedema

Alternate spelling; see *Lymphedema*.

Lymphofollicular Hyperplasia

Lymphofollicular hyperplasia is enlargement or increased formation of lymphoid follicles in response to immune stimulation, infection, inflammation, or other triggers.

Lymphogranuloma Venereum

A sexually transmitted infection caused by invasive L1, L2, or L3 serovars of *Chlamydia trachomatis*. It may cause a transient painless genital ulcer followed by tender groin lymph-node swelling or rectal inflammation with pain, bleeding, or discharge.

Alternate Names:
LGV; Fourth Venereal Disease

Lymphoid

Resembling or relating to lymphatic tissue, lymphocytes, or organs involved in lymphocyte development

and immune function.

Lymphoid Hyperplasia

Lymphoid hyperplasia is benign increase in lymphoid tissue caused by immune stimulation, infection, inflammation, or sometimes a reactive response near a tumor.

Lymphoid Organs

Organs that contain lymphoid tissue and support the development, storage, or activity of immune cells. They include the bone marrow, thymus, lymph nodes, spleen, and tonsils.

Lymphoid Tissue

Tissue containing lymphocytes and supporting immune responses, found in lymph nodes, spleen, thymus, tonsils, and mucosal sites.

Lymphokine

Older term; see *Cytokine*.

Lymphoma

A cancer of lymphocytes, immune cells that include B cells, T cells, and natural killer cells. Lymphomas are broadly classified as Hodgkin lymphoma or non-Hodgkin lymphoma and can arise in lymph nodes or other lymphatic tissues and organs. They may cause painless enlarged lymph nodes, fever, drenching night sweats, weight loss, or symptoms from an affected organ.

Lymphoma Overview

Alternate name; see *Lymphoma*.

Lymphomatoid Granulomatosis

A rare Epstein-Barr-virus-associated lymphoproliferative disorder that commonly involves the lungs and may also affect the skin, central nervous system, or kidneys. It can produce nodules, cough, breathlessness, or systemic symptoms; diagnosis is based on tissue findings, and treatment varies with disease extent.

Lymphomatoid Papulosis

Lymphomatoid papulosis is a chronic, recurring skin disorder with cancer-like immune cells. The bumps often heal on their own, but some people later develop lymphoma.

Lymphopenia

Alternate name; see *Lymphocytopenia*.

Lymphoplasmacytic Lymphoma

A rare, usually slow-growing lymphoma that develops in bone marrow and lymphoid tissues. When it makes an abnormal IgM antibody, it is called Waldenström macroglobulinemia.

Lymphopoiesis

The production and development of lymphocytes, a group of white blood cells that help fight infection and abnormal cells. These cells develop mainly in the bone marrow and thymus.

Lymphoproliferative Disorder

A condition in which lymphocytes multiply excessively or abnormally. It may be temporary after infection or immune stimulation, or may represent a cancer such as leukemia or lymphoma.

Lymphoscintigraphy

A scan that follows a small radioactive tracer through lymph vessels. It can map drainage to the first lymph node draining a tumor or show impaired lymph flow in lymphedema and other disorders.

Lymph System

The lymph system includes lymph, lymphatic vessels, lymph nodes, spleen, thymus, and related tissues that return fluid and support immune defense.

Lynch Syndrome

An inherited condition that greatly increases the risk of colorectal, womb, ovarian, stomach, urinary-tract, and several other cancers. Risk management can include regular screening and genetic counseling or testing for relatives.

Lysergic Acid Diethylamide

A potent hallucinogenic drug (psychedelic) classified as a Schedule 1 controlled substance (high abuse potential, no accepted medical use). LSD acts as a partial agonist at serotonin 5-HT2A receptors in the prefrontal cortex, leading to altered sensory perception, mood, and cognition.

Lysine

Lysine is an essential amino acid needed for protein production, growth, and tissue repair; it must be obtained from food.

Lysis

The breakdown, dissolution, or destruction of cells or tissue; examples include hemolysis, the breakdown of red blood cells, and thrombolysis, the dissolution of a blood clot.

Lysogenic Conversion

A change in a bacterium's characteristics after a virus that infects bacteria inserts its genetic material into the bacterial chromosome and provides new genes, such as genes that increase disease-causing ability.

Lysogeny

Lysogeny is a state in which a bacteriophage's genetic material is maintained inside a bacterial cell and replicated with the host genome.

Lysophagy

A form of selective autophagy that removes damaged lysosomes, the cell compartments that digest waste. It helps maintain cell health; failure of lysophagy can allow damaged lysosomes to accumulate and promote inflammation or cell injury.

Lysophosphatidylcholine

A fat-like molecule found in cell membranes and blood. It helps transport fats and can influence inflammation and cell communication; abnormal levels may occur in metabolic or inflammatory diseases.

Lysophospholipids

Lipids related to phospholipids but containing one fewer fatty-acid chain. They are parts of cell membranes and can act as signaling molecules, influencing inflammation, blood vessels, immune responses, and cell movement.

Lysosomal Storage Disorders

A group of inherited diseases in which missing or faulty lysosomal enzymes cause substances to build up inside cells. Accumulation can damage organs, bones, nerves, or other tissues; treatment depends on the specific disorder.

Lysosome

A small compartment inside a cell containing substances that break down waste, worn-out cell parts, and material brought into the cell. Lysosome disorders can cause harmful material to accumulate in tissues.

Lysozyme

A natural enzyme that helps defend against bacteria by breaking down part of their protective outer wall. It is found in tears, saliva, breast milk, and some immune cells.

Lysozyme Test

A lysozyme test measures the enzyme lysozyme in a sample and may support evaluation of selected blood, inflammatory, or infectious disorders.

Lyssavirus

A group of viruses that includes rabies virus and related viruses. They mainly spread through the bite or saliva of an infected mammal and can cause a severe brain infection; post-exposure vaccination can prevent disease before symptoms begin.

Lytic

Causing or involving lysis, or the breakdown of cells, tissue, or another biological structure; a lytic bone lesion is an area of bone destruction.

Lytic Lesion

A lytic lesion is an area of bone destruction caused by processes such as cancer, infection, or some metabolic bone disorders.

Manual Lymphatic Drainage

A gentle, specialized massage technique intended to move lymph from swollen tissue toward functioning lymphatic pathways. It is used as one component of decongestive therapy for lymphedema, often alongside compression, exercise, and skin care.

Alternate Names:
Lymphatic Drainage Massage; Lymphatic Drain Massage; Manual Lymph Drainage

M

MacConkey Agar
A laboratory growth medium used mainly to grow and distinguish certain intestinal bacteria. It helps show whether bacteria can break down lactose, a sugar.

Macerate
To soften and break down tissue after prolonged contact with fluid. The term may describe skin, wounds, or changes in a fetus that has died before delivery.

Maceration
Softening and breakdown of tissue caused by prolonged exposure to moisture or fluid; it may occur in skin, wounds, or a fetus after death.

Macewen Sign
An unusually hollow sound heard when part of the skull is tapped. It may occur with enlarged fluid spaces in the brain or rarely a brain abscess, but it cannot diagnose either condition by itself.

Machupo Virus
An arenavirus that causes Bolivian hemorrhagic fever, a potentially fatal illness characterized by fever, pain, and bleeding; it is endemic in parts of Bolivia.

Macroamylasemia
Macroamylasemia is a benign condition in which amylase binds to immunoglobulin and remains in blood, causing high serum amylase with low urinary clearance.

Macroangiopathy
A disease of the body's larger blood vessels, often caused by fatty buildup or a blood clot. It can reduce blood flow to the heart, brain, legs, or other organs.

Macroautophagy
A cell-cleaning process in which a cell encloses damaged parts or unwanted proteins, breaks them down, and reuses some of their materials. It helps maintain cell health during stress and normal turnover.

Macrocephalus
Alternate name; see *Macrocephaly*.

Macrocephaly
An abnormally large head, usually defined in children by a head circumference more than two standard deviations above the mean or above the 97th percentile for age and sex. It may be familial or result from enlarged brain tissue, excess fluid, or another condition.

Macrocyte
An abnormally large red blood cell, commonly seen in macrocytosis and megaloblastic or other anemias.

Macrocytic
Describing a cell, especially a red blood cell, that is abnormally large; macrocytic anemia features enlarged red blood cells.

Macrocytic Anaemia
Alternate British spelling; see *Macrocytic Anemia*.

Macrocytic Anemia

Anemia in which red blood cells are larger than usual. Common causes include vitamin B12 or folate deficiency, alcohol use, liver disease, underactive thyroid, some bone-marrow disorders, and recovery from blood loss. It may cause tiredness, pale skin, shortness of breath, or tingling.

Alternate Names:
Macrocytosis; Large-Cell Anemia; High-MCV Anemia

Macrocytosis

An abnormal enlargement of mature circulating red blood cells defined by a mean corpuscular volume (MCV) exceeding 100 fL, commonly resulting from vitamin B12 or folate deficiency (megaloblastic anemia), alcoholism, chronic liver disease, reticulocytosis, or myelodysplastic syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Macrocytic Erythrocytes; Elevated MCV

Macrodactyly

Fingers or toes that are unusually large because their bones and soft tissues overgrow. It is usually present from birth, may affect one digit or several, and can interfere with movement or footwear.

Macrodontia

Teeth that are larger than expected. It may affect one tooth or many teeth and can cause crowding, bite problems, or difficulty cleaning; treatment depends on the cause and symptoms.

Macrogenitosomia

Unusual enlargement of the external genitals caused by excessive hormone activity before birth or during childhood. Possible causes include disorders of the adrenal glands, testes, ovaries, or other hormone systems.

Macroglobulin

A large protein in the blood, often made of several protein units joined together. Immunoglobulin M is a major example; abnormal amounts can occur in some immune or blood disorders.

Macroglossia

An unusually large tongue. It may be present from birth or develop later and can affect breathing, eating, speaking, or tooth growth.

Macrognathia

An abnormally large jaw. It may result from excessive bone growth, an inherited condition, or another disorder. It is distinct from prognathism, in which the jaw projects forward.

Macrolide

A class of antibiotics, including azithromycin, clarithromycin, and erythromycin, that treat bacterial infections by stopping bacteria from producing the essential proteins they need to grow and multiply. They are commonly used to treat respiratory tract infections, skin infections, and certain sexually transmitted infections.

Macrolides

Plural form; see *Macrolide*.

Macronutrients

Nutrients needed in large amounts, mainly carbohydrates, proteins, and fats. They provide energy, build and repair tissues, support hormones and cell membranes, and help maintain normal body functions.

Macrophage

A large immune cell that surrounds and removes germs, dead cells, and debris. It also helps coordinate inflammation and tissue repair.

Macrophage Activation

The process by which macrophages, a type of immune cell, respond to infection or tissue injury. They may destroy germs and damaged cells, alert other immune cells, and release substances that promote inflammation or repair.

Macrophage Activation Syndrome

A severe systemic hyperinflammatory syndrome, considered a form of secondary hemophagocytic

lymphohistiocytosis (HLH), that most often complicates rheumatic diseases such as systemic juvenile idiopathic arthritis, adult-onset Still disease, or lupus. Features include persistent fever, markedly elevated ferritin, low blood-cell counts, liver inflammation, and disordered blood clotting; severe cases can progress to multiple-organ dysfunction.

Macrophage Count

The number or percentage of macrophages found in a tissue, body fluid, or laboratory sample. The result may help assess infection, inflammation, tissue repair, or a blood disorder, but its meaning depends on the sample and other findings.

Macropsia

A visual disturbance in which objects appear larger than they really are. It may occur with migraine, seizures, retinal problems, medicines, or brain disorders and can temporarily affect depth and distance judgment.

Macroscopic

Large enough to be seen without a microscope. A macroscopic examination records a specimen's visible size, shape, color, surface, and other gross features before microscopic testing.

Macroscopic Hematuria

Visible blood in the urine, also called gross hematuria; it may arise from the kidneys, ureters, bladder, prostate, or urethra and can be caused by infection, stones, trauma, or malignancy.

Macrosomia

Excessive fetal or newborn size, usually defined by an estimated fetal weight or birth weight above 4,000 to 4,500 g, regardless of gestational age. Thresholds vary. It differs from large for gestational age, which means weight above the 90th percentile for gestational age.

Macrostomia

An abnormally wide mouth or oral opening, usually a congenital facial cleft caused by incomplete fusion of the embryonic facial processes.

Macula

The central part of the retina responsible for sharp, detailed, and color vision. Damage from aging, diabetes, inflammation, or other disease can cause blurred, distorted, or missing central vision.

Macula Densa

A group of specialized cells in the kidney tubule that senses sodium chloride in the filtrate. These cells help regulate renin release and the kidney's filtration rate.

Macula Lutea

The small yellowish area in the center of the retina responsible for sharp vision. Its center, called the fovea, provides the clearest vision.

Macular

Relating to a macule, a flat, circumscribed change in skin color without a change in texture or elevation. Macules may be caused by pigment, inflammation, vascular change, or other processes and are distinguished from raised lesions such as papules.

Macular Amyloidosis

A localized cutaneous amyloidosis characterized by mottled or rippled brown-gray patches, usually on the upper back. It is often associated with chronic friction or rubbing and is distinct from systemic amyloidosis.

Macular Cyst

A cystic defect in the macula, the central retinal area responsible for sharp vision, often associated with vitreous traction and potentially causing distortion or loss of central vision.

Macular Degeneration

A general term for disorders that damage the macula, the central part of the retina responsible for detailed straight-ahead vision. Age-related macular degeneration is a common form and has dry (atrophic) and wet (neovascular) types; inherited and other disorders can also cause macular degeneration.

Macular Drusen

Small yellow deposits beneath the retina in the macula, the area responsible for sharp central vision. A few small deposits may occur with aging, while many large deposits can signal increased risk of macular degeneration.

Macular Edema

Swelling of the macula caused by fluid collecting within the retina, often after blood vessels leak. It can blur or distort central vision and may occur with diabetic retinopathy, retinal vein occlusion, inflammation, or after eye surgery.

Macular Hole

A full-thickness opening in the fovea, the center of the macula, often caused by traction between the vitreous gel and retina. It may cause blurred or distorted central vision or a central blind spot.

Macular Pucker

Alternate name; see *Epiretinal Membrane*.

Macular Skin Lesion

Relating to a macule, a small, flat, circumscribed change in skin color that is neither raised nor depressed.

Macular Sparing

Preservation of central vision despite loss of the surrounding half of the visual field, often after damage to visual pathways. It may occur after a stroke in the occipital lobe, but the mechanism varies.

Macule

A small, flat, discolored area of skin or mucous membrane that does not change the skin's thickness or texture, typically measuring up to 1 centimeter across. Macules can be darker than surrounding skin (such as a freckle or mole), lighter (such as in vitiligo), or reddish from widened tiny blood vessels. Larger flat patches of discoloration are called patches.

Macules

Plural form; see *Macule*.

Maculopapular Lesion

A skin lesion combining flat areas of altered color (macules) with small raised solid lesions (papules); it can occur in infections, drug eruptions, inflammatory diseases, and other conditions.

Madarosis

Loss or absence of eyelashes, eyebrows, or other hair, caused by local disease, inflammation, trauma, or systemic conditions.

Mad Cow Disease

Alternate name; see *Bovine Spongiform Encephalopathy*.

Maddrey Discriminant Function

A score used to estimate the severity of alcohol-associated hepatitis. It uses blood clotting time and bilirubin level; a score of 32 or higher suggests severe disease and helps clinicians assess treatment options.

Alternate Names:
MDF; Maddrey DF Score

Madelung Deformity

A wrist deformity caused by abnormal growth of the volar-ulnar part of the distal radius, producing altered wrist alignment. It may be isolated, inherited, or associated with conditions such as Leri-Weill dyschondrosteosis; pain or limited movement can occur.

Alternate Names:
Madelung Wrist

Madura Foot

A chronic localized infection of the skin and deeper tissues of the foot, caused by fungi or certain bacteria and characterized by swelling, draining sinuses, and granules.

Alternate Names:
Mycetoma Pedis; Maduromycosis

Maduramycosis

Mycetoma, a chronic subcutaneous infection caused by true fungi or filamentous bacteria and characterized by swelling, sinuses, and granules.

Madurella

Madurella is a genus of fungi that can cause mycetoma, a chronic infection of skin and deeper tissue after implantation through the skin.

Madurella Mycetomatis

A fungus that commonly causes eumycetoma, a chronic infection producing nodules, draining sinuses, and grains, usually after traumatic implantation in the foot or limb.

Maffucci Syndrome

A rare condition causing multiple benign cartilage growths and abnormal blood-vessel growths, usually beginning in childhood. It can deform bones, cause fractures, and increase the risk of certain cancers.

MAG3 Renal Scan

A kidney scan that uses a small radioactive tracer to show how well each kidney works and how urine drains. It can help detect blockage or delayed drainage.

Magenblase Syndrome

Stomach discomfort and bloating caused by swallowing too much air, often while eating or drinking. The swallowed air may cause burping, fullness, or visible swelling and can be worsened by chewing gum, fizzy drinks, eating quickly, or anxiety.

Magnesium

A mineral needed for healthy nerves, muscles, bones, heart rhythm, and many body processes. Too little can cause weakness, tremor, muscle cramps, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Magnesium Blood Test

A blood test measuring serum magnesium, an electrolyte involved in neuromuscular function, cardiac rhythm, and metabolism; it helps evaluate deficiency, excess, and related electrolyte disorders.

Magnesium Carbonate

A magnesium salt used in some antacid or laxative preparations and as a magnesium supplement; excessive intake may cause toxicity, especially in renal failure.

Magnesium Chloride

A magnesium salt used in some oral supplements and medical preparations to provide magnesium or, in concentrated solutions, to help correct magnesium deficiency; dosing depends on the elemental magnesium content.

Magnesium Deficiency

An abnormally low body magnesium level, often caused by poor intake, gastrointestinal loss, renal wasting, or medications. It may cause weakness, tremor, muscle cramps, seizures, cardiac arrhythmias, hypokalemia, and hypocalcemia.

Magnesium Hydroxide

An osmotic laxative and antacid that neutralizes gastric acid and draws water into the bowel.

Magnesium In Diet

Dietary magnesium comes from foods such as nuts, seeds, legumes, whole grains, and leafy vegetables and supports nerve, muscle, bone, and heart function.

Magnesium Oxide

An inorganic magnesium compound used in some supplements and antacids; it can also have a laxative effect, and excessive use may cause hypermagnesemia, especially with kidney impairment.

Magnesium Sulfate

A magnesium salt used intravenously or intramuscularly to treat selected magnesium deficiencies and conditions such as eclampsia, and used orally as an osmotic laxative; it is also known as Epsom salt in its hydrated form.

Magnesium Sulfate For Neuroprotection

Magnesium given through a vein before some very early preterm births to lower the baby's risk of brain injury. The timing and dose are guided by obstetric and newborn-care specialists.

Magnesium Sulphate

A magnesium salt used medically for severe magnesium deficiency, prevention or treatment of eclamptic seizures, and selected arrhythmias or asthma indications.

Magnesium Test

A blood test measuring serum magnesium, an essential electrolyte involved in neuromuscular transmission, enzymatic reactions, and cardiac rhythm regulation; see *Magnesium*.

Magnetic Resonance Angiography

MRI techniques used to depict arteries or veins, with or without contrast. It may evaluate stenosis, aneurysm, dissection, thrombosis, and vascular malformation without ionizing radiation.

Magnetic Resonance Cholangiopancreatography

A special MRI scan that shows the bile ducts, gallbladder, and pancreatic duct without inserting a camera into them. It can detect stones, narrowing, inflammation, leaks, and some blockages without using X-rays.

Alternate Names:
MRCP; MR Cholangiopancreatography

Magnetic Resonance Imaging

A scan that uses a strong magnetic field and radio waves to make detailed pictures inside the body without X-rays. It is especially useful for the brain, spinal cord, joints, muscles, and many organs; some scans require injected contrast.

Magnetic Resonance Safety

Procedures used during an MRI scan to prevent injury from the strong magnet, radio waves, heating, loud noise, and metal objects. Screening covers implants, metal fragments, medicines, pregnancy, and other risks before scanning.

Magnetic Resonance Spectroscopy

A special MRI test that measures chemicals in tissue rather than only making a picture of its shape. It may help study brain disorders or provide extra information about a tumor; results are considered alongside ordinary imaging and other tests.

Magnetic Resonance Urography

An MRI scan of the kidneys, ureters, and bladder. It shows the urinary tract without X-rays and may be performed with or without contrast material.

Magnetic Resonance Venography

An MRI test that produces images of veins, with or without injected contrast. It can assess suspected clots or narrowing in veins of the brain, abdomen, pelvis, or limbs and does not use X-rays.

Alternate Names:
MRV; MR Venography

Magnetic Seed

A tiny magnetic marker placed in a breast lesion or lymph node to help a surgeon find it. A special detector locates the marker during surgery, providing an alternative to some wire or radioactive-marker methods.

Magnetic Therapy

Treatment that uses a magnetic field for a health purpose. Ordinary static magnets have not been shown to treat disease, while specialized magnetic stimulation devices have established uses for some neurologic or psychiatric conditions.

Magnetocardiography

A test that records the very weak magnetic fields produced by the heart's electrical activity using sensors outside the body. It may help study heart rhythm or electrical conduction, usually in specialist or research settings.

Magnetoencephalography

A noninvasive technique that records the weak magnetic fields produced by neuronal electrical activity, using sensors outside the head to localize and study brain function and some epileptic discharges.

Magnusiomyces Capitatus

An opportunistic yeast formerly known as *Geotrichum capitatum* or *Saprochaete capitata*; it can cause invasive infections, especially in people with severe immunosuppression or hematologic malignancy.

Mahvash Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which the body's cells do not respond normally to glucagon, a hormone that helps raise blood sugar. It can enlarge the pancreas, increase glucagon levels, and disturb blood-sugar control.

Main-En-Griffe

A claw-like hand position usually caused by damage to the ulnar nerve, which controls several hand muscles. The ring and little fingers may bend at the smaller joints, weaken the grip, and become difficult to straighten.

Maintenance

Ongoing care or treatment intended to preserve health, prevent relapse or deterioration, or sustain a therapeutic result; maintenance therapy is continued after initial control of a condition.

Maintenance Dose

The regular amount of a medicine needed to keep its effect at the desired level. The dose depends on how quickly the body removes the medicine and how much the body absorbs.

Maintenance Of Wakefulness Test

A sleep test that measures how long a person can remain awake in a quiet setting during the day.

Maintenance Therapy

Treatment continued after a disease has improved or been controlled to maintain that benefit, prevent return or worsening, or delay progression. The treatment may be a medicine, procedure, or other care, and its duration depends on the condition, response, risks, and treatment goals.

Maisonneuve Fracture

A spiral fracture of the proximal third of the fibula associated with disruption of the distal tibiofibular syndesmosis, interosseous membrane, and either an avulsion fracture of the medial malleolus or rupture of the deep deltoid ligament of the ankle.

Maize

Corn, a cereal grain used as food and feed; contaminated maize can expose people to fungal toxins such as aflatoxin.

Majeed Syndrome

A rare autoinflammatory disorder caused by LPIN2 variants, characterized by chronic recurrent multifocal osteomyelitis, congenital dyserythropoietic anemia, and inflammatory skin disease.

Majewski Syndrome

A rare inherited skeletal disorder involving abnormal bone growth and distinctive craniofacial or limb findings; the exact features depend on the genetic subtype.

Majocchi Granuloma

A deep follicular infection caused by dermatophyte fungi, producing inflamed papules, pustules, or nodules and sometimes abscesses. It often follows shaving or topical steroid use and requires systemic antifungal treatment rather than topical therapy alone.

Major

Larger, greater, or more significant than another related structure or condition; for example, the teres major muscle is larger than the teres minor muscle.

Major Depression

Alternate name; see *Major Depressive Disorder*.

Major Depression With Psychotic Features

A major depressive episode accompanied by delusions or hallucinations, usually mood-congruent, with significant safety and functional implications.

Major Depressive Disorder

A mood disorder involving one or more major depressive episodes. During an episode, five or more symptoms occur during the same two-week period, including either depressed mood or loss of interest or pleasure (anhedonia). Other symptoms may include changes in sleep, appetite, energy, concentration, movement, guilt, worthlessness, or thoughts of death. The symptoms cause clinically significant distress or impairment.

Alternate Names:
Major Depression

Major Depressive Episode

A period of at least two weeks with depressed mood or loss of interest or pleasure plus additional emotional, cognitive, physical, or behavioral symptoms that cause significant distress or impairment. It may occur in major depressive disorder, bipolar disorder, or other conditions and must be distinguished from symptoms caused by substances or another medical condition.

Major Histocompatibility Complex

A group of genes that encode cell-surface proteins used to display protein fragments to T cells. These proteins help the immune system recognize infected or abnormal cells; in humans, they are called human leukocyte antigens (HLA).

Major Histocompatibility Complex Molecule

A cell-surface protein that displays small pieces of germs or abnormal cells to immune cells. This helps the immune system recognize what belongs to the body and what may need an immune response.

Alternate Names:
MHC Molecule

Major Trauma

A serious injury that may threaten life, limb, or organ function. It can involve multiple body regions or major damage to the brain, spine, chest, abdomen, pelvis, or blood vessels.

Malabsorption

A condition in which the body cannot properly digest or absorb nutrients from food. It may cause chronic diarrhea, greasy stools, weight loss, anemia, or vitamin and mineral deficiencies.

Malabsorption Syndrome

Impaired absorption of nutrients from the small intestine, causing diarrhea, weight loss, anemia, vitamin deficiencies, or other nutritional complications.

Malacia

Abnormal softening or weakening of tissue. It may affect cartilage, bone, or brain tissue after faulty development, injury, infection, reduced blood supply, or another disease; symptoms depend on the tissue involved.

Malacoplakia

Alternate spelling; see *Malakoplakia*.

Maladaptation

An adjustment to a situation or environment that does not work well and harms health or daily functioning. The term may describe physical, psychological, or behavioral responses to illness or stress.

Maladaptive Stress Response

A lasting or overly strong reaction to stress that interferes with health, daily life, or relationships. It may include constant worry, poor sleep, irritability, avoidance, or physical symptoms and can improve with support and appropriate treatment.

Malaise

Malaise is a general feeling of illness, discomfort, or lack of well-being that commonly accompanies infection, inflammation, chronic disease, medication effects, or other systemic conditions.

Malakoplakia

A rare inflammatory disorder, often affecting the bladder, in which defective macrophage function is associated with distinctive mineralized inclusions called Michaelis-Gutmann bodies. It can form a mass that resembles cancer and may also involve the digestive tract or other organs.

Malar

Relating to the cheekbone or cheek area. A malar rash is a red or purple rash across the cheeks and bridge of the nose, often seen in lupus. A malar fracture is a break in the cheekbone and may cause swelling, numbness, or a changed facial shape.

Malaria

A serious and potentially life-threatening infectious disease caused by *Plasmodium* parasites, which are transmitted to humans through the bites of infected female *Anopheles* mosquitoes. Once inside the body, the parasites multiply in the liver before invading and destroying red blood cells. This cyclical destruction causes recurring bouts of high fever, chills, sweating, and severe fatigue, and can lead to dangerous complications such as severe anemia, kidney failure, or brain damage (cerebral malaria).

Malar Rash

A red or violaceous rash across the cheeks and bridge of the nose, often sparing the folds beside the nose. It is classically associated with systemic lupus erythematosus but can occur with other conditions; appearance alone does not establish a diagnosis.

Malassezia

Malassezia is a yeast normally found on skin that can contribute to dandruff, seborrheic dermatitis, pityriasis versicolor, and some folliculitis.

Malassezia Furfur

Malassezia furfur is a yeast that normally lives on skin but can multiply excessively. It is linked with dandruff, oily skin inflammation, and pityriasis versicolor, which causes lighter or darker patches.

Malassezia (Pityrosporum) Folliculitis

An overgrowth of Malassezia yeast in hair follicles causing many small, itchy, fairly uniform papules and pustules, usually on the chest, back, shoulders, or forehead. Heat, sweating, antibiotics, oils, and immune suppression can contribute.

Malassimilation

Failure to properly digest food or absorb its nutrients. It may cause diarrhea, weight loss, bloating, anemia, or vitamin shortages and can result from pancreatic disease, bowel disorders, surgery, infection, or food intolerance.

Malate Dehydrogenase

An enzyme in energy-producing pathways that changes malate into oxaloacetate. It helps cells process nutrients and is involved in transferring chemical energy within mitochondria and other cellular compartments.

Malathion

An organophosphate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase; topical formulations have also been used to treat head lice, but exposure or ingestion can cause cholinergic toxicity.

Malathion Poisoning

Poisoning caused by the insecticide malathion. It can produce sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, wheezing, slow heartbeat, muscle twitching, weakness, seizures, or breathing failure.

MALDI-TOF Mass Spectrometry

A laboratory method that identifies bacteria or fungi by comparing their protein pattern with a reference database. It can identify an organism quickly, but separate testing is needed to determine antibiotic sensitivity.

Male

Describing a sex associated with reproductive anatomy that produces or is organized around small gametes (sperm); chromosomes, hormones, anatomy, and gender identity do not always fit a simple binary pattern.

Male Breast Cancer

Cancer developing in breast tissue in a man. It is uncommon and may cause a new lump, nipple discharge, skin change, or nipple retraction.

Alternate Names:
Male Mammary Carcinoma; Breast Carcinoma in Men

Male Breast Pathology

Disorders affecting male breast tissue, including gynecomastia, benign epithelial lesions, inflammatory conditions, and carcinoma. Evaluation of a persistent mass or nipple change may include clinical examination, imaging, and biopsy.

Male Chlamydial Infection

A sexually transmitted infection in men caused by *Chlamydia trachomatis* (serovars D–K), most frequently manifesting as non-gonococcal urethritis, epididymo-orchitis, or proctitis, characterized by dysuria, mucoid urethral discharge, and testicular tenderness.

Alternate Names:
Chlamydia in Men; Male Chlamydia

Male Condom

A thin sheath placed over the penis before sexual contact to reduce the risk of pregnancy and transmission of many sexually transmitted infections by acting as a physical barrier.

Male Genitalia

The external and internal reproductive organs of a male, including the penis, scrotum, testes, epididymides, vas deferens, seminal vesicles, prostate, and associated ducts and glands.

Male Genital Sores

Ulcerations, blisters, or skin lesions on the penis, scrotum, or perianal region. Major causes include sexually transmitted infections (such as genital herpes, syphilis, and chancroid), infectious balanitis, inflammatory skin diseases, fixed drug eruptions, trauma, or penile neoplasia.

Alternate Names:
Male Genital Ulcers

Male Groin Pain

Pain in the groin or adjacent lower abdomen, hip, or testicle in a male; causes include muscle strain, hernia, infection, urinary stones, or referred pain.

Male Hypoactive Sexual Desire Disorder

Persistently reduced sexual thoughts or desire in a man that causes personal distress or relationship difficulty. It differs from erection problems, although both can occur together; medicines, illness, mood, and relationship factors may contribute.

Male Hypogonadism

Dysfunction of the testes or hypothalamic-pituitary-gonadal axis that impairs testosterone production, sperm production, or both. In adults, androgen deficiency is generally diagnosed when compatible symptoms or signs accompany consistently low serum testosterone; a low measurement alone is insufficient. Features may include reduced libido, erectile difficulty, infertility, or loss of muscle or bone mass.

Alternate Names:
Adult Male Hypogonadism

Male Infertility

Reduced ability to achieve a pregnancy because of factors affecting sperm production, sperm transport, ejaculation, sexual function, or other reproductive processes.

Alternate Names:
Male Subfertility; Male Factor Infertility

Male Menopause

An informal term sometimes used for age-related changes in testosterone. Unlike menopause, testosterone usually declines gradually, and the term is not a diagnosis; see *Male Hypogonadism*.

Male Pattern Baldness

Androgenetic alopecia, a patterned progressive loss of scalp hair caused by genetic susceptibility and androgen effects on hair follicles.

Male Pelvis

The bony pelvis associated with typical male development. On average, it is narrower and deeper than a pelvis associated with typical female development, though anatomy varies among individuals.

Male Phenotype

The observable reproductive anatomy, secondary sex characteristics, and other traits associated with male sex development, produced by interacting genetic, hormonal, and developmental factors and showing natural variation.

Male Reproductive System

The organs and tissues that produce sperm and male sex hormones and deliver sperm, including the testes, ducts, accessory glands, penis, and scrotum.

Male Self-Catheterization

Intermittent insertion and removal of a catheter through the male urethra to drain the bladder when neurologic, obstructive, or other conditions prevent adequate emptying.

Male Sexual Problems

Sexual symptoms in men, including erectile dysfunction, reduced desire, ejaculation disorders, infertility, or penile curvature; causes may be vascular, hormonal, neurologic, medication-related, psychological, or mixed.

Male Urethritis

Inflammation of the male urethra, commonly caused by sexually transmitted infection but also by irritation or other infection. Dysuria, urethral discharge, itching, or meatal irritation may occur.

Malformation

An abnormal structural development present from birth, caused by disturbed formation of an organ or body part.

Malignancy

Cancerous disease in which abnormal cells grow uncontrollably and may invade nearby tissue or spread to distant organs. Its likely behavior and treatment depend on the cancer type, extent, grade, and important molecular findings.

Malignancy-Associated Hypercoagulability

A cancer-related tendency toward excessive clot formation caused by tumor-associated coagulation activation, inflammation, platelet interaction, treatment, immobility, or vascular injury. See *Cancer-Associated Thrombosis*.

Malignant

Cancerous, with the ability to invade nearby tissues or spread to distant parts of the body. Malignant cells grow abnormally and may damage organs, but behavior varies among cancer types and stages.

Malignant Acanthosis Nigricans

A paraneoplastic syndrome in which velvety, hyperpigmented, verrucous plaques develop rapidly in flexural and mucosal areas as a marker of an underlying internal malignancy, most commonly gastric adenocarcinoma. Unlike benign acanthosis nigricans, the malignant form is extensive, abrupt in onset, and may involve the oral mucosa.

Malignant Ameloblastoma

A rare cancer arising from ameloblastoma-forming tissue, usually in the jaw, with potential to invade locally or spread to distant organs.

Malignant Appendical Tumor

Malignant tumor arising in the appendix; see *Appendiceal Cancer*.

Malignant Ascites

Buildup of fluid in the abdomen caused by cancer involving the abdominal lining or nearby organs. It can cause swelling, discomfort, early fullness, nausea, or breathlessness and may require drainage and cancer-directed treatment.

Malignant Atrophic Papulosis

Alternate name; see *Degos Disease (Malignant At-*

rophic Papulosis).

Malignant Bone Neoplasm

A cancer that begins in bone or nearby supporting tissue. It may cause persistent bone pain, swelling, or a fracture; scans and a biopsy identify the type and extent before treatment.

Malignant Carcinoid Syndrome

Severe carcinoid syndrome caused by hormone-releasing neuroendocrine cancer, potentially producing flushing, diarrhea, bronchospasm, right-sided heart-valve disease, and hemodynamic complications; see *Carcinoid Syndrome*.

Malignant Fibrous Histiocytoma

Alternate name; see *Undifferentiated Pleomorphic Sarcoma*.

Malignant Giant Cell Tumor Of Tendon Sheath

A rare locally aggressive malignant tumor resembling a giant cell tumor of tendon sheath, characterized by destructive growth and potential for metastasis; expert soft-tissue pathology helps establish the diagnosis.

Malignant Glioma

An aggressive primary tumor arising from glial or glial-like cells of the central nervous system; high-grade examples include anaplastic astrocytoma and glioblastoma.

Malignant Hypertension

A severe form of hypertension characterized by advanced hypertensive retinopathy, classically retinal hemorrhages and exudates with or without papilledema, and small-vessel injury. Acute kidney, brain, heart, or other organ damage may also occur.

Malignant Hyperthermia

A rare, life-threatening genetic reaction that occurs in susceptible individuals when exposed to certain general anesthetics and muscle relaxants during surgery. The condition causes an uncontrolled release of calcium inside skeletal muscle cells, leading to sustained muscle rigidity, an abrupt and extreme rise in body temperature, a rapid heart rate, and massive muscle tissue breakdown.

Malignant Large Bowel Tumor

Cancer arising in the colon or rectum; see *Colorectal Cancer*.

Malignant Mastocytosis

An older name for a severe disorder in which abnormal mast cells multiply and collect in organs. It can damage the bone marrow, liver, spleen, or other tissues and may cause flushing, faintness, bleeding, or organ failure.

Malignant Melanoma

Alternate name; see *Melanoma*.

Malignant Mesothelioma

A cancer of the thin lining around the lungs, abdomen, or heart. It is strongly linked to asbestos exposure and may cause chest or abdominal pain, fluid buildup, cough, or breathlessness.

Malignant Myoepithelioma

A rare cancer arising from supportive contractile cells in a gland, most often a salivary gland. It can grow into nearby tissue and spread elsewhere, causing a slowly enlarging or painful mass.

Malignant Neoplasm

A cancerous growth in which abnormal cells multiply without control, invade nearby tissues, and may spread to distant organs through the blood or lymphatic system.

Alternate Names:
Cancer; Malignancy

Malignant Neoplasms of the Small Intestine

Alternate name; see *Small Intestine Cancer*.

Malignant Otitis Externa

An older name for necrotizing otitis externa, an

invasive infection of the external ear canal that can spread to the skull base. It usually affects older adults with diabetes or people with weakened immunity and can cause severe pain or cranial-nerve problems.

Malignant Peripheral Nerve Sheath Tumor

An uncommon soft-tissue cancer arising from or near peripheral nerves. It may cause a growing painful mass, numbness, or weakness and is treated with specialist surgery, radiation, or medicines when appropriate.

Malignant Pleural Effusion

Buildup of fluid around the lung because cancer involves the lung lining or has spread there. It may cause breathlessness, chest discomfort, or cough; drainage relieves symptoms, while cancer treatment may reduce recurrence.

Malignant Pustule

An older name for the skin form of anthrax, caused by Bacillus anthracis and beginning as an itchy papule that develops into a painless black eschar.

Malignant Syphilis

A severe form of secondary syphilis that causes fever and widespread crusted, ulcerated, or tissue-damaging skin lesions. It is more common with weakened immunity and is treated with antibiotic therapy for syphilis.

Malignant Teratoma Of The Mediastinum

A malignant germ-cell tumor containing tissues from more than one embryonic layer and arising in the mediastinum; evaluation uses imaging, tumor markers, and tissue diagnosis.

Malignant Thymoma

An older term for an invasive thymic epithelial tumor; modern usage distinguishes invasive thymoma from thymic carcinoma, which is a separate, more aggressive thymic malignancy.

Malignant Tumor

A cancerous growth capable of invading nearby tissue or spreading to distant sites. Its behavior and treatment depend on its type, grade, stage, and molecular features.

Malignant Vulvar Lesions

Cancerous or potentially invasive lesions of the vulva, most commonly squamous-cell carcinoma but also melanoma, adenocarcinoma, basal-cell carcinoma, or sarcoma. Persistent, ulcerated, pigmented, bleeding, painful, or changing lesions may need examination and biopsy for diagnosis.

Malingering

Deliberately pretending to have, or exaggerating, symptoms to obtain an outside benefit such as money, medicines, shelter, or avoiding an obligation. It is not itself a mental illness; diagnosis depends on reliable evidence.

Mallampati Classification

A grading system used before anesthesia to estimate how difficult it may be to place a breathing tube. The clinician looks inside the open mouth and records which parts of the throat can be seen; it is only one part of the airway assessment.

Malleolus

A bony prominence at the ankle formed by the lower end of the tibia medially or fibula laterally.

Mallet

A surgical hammer used with tools such as osteotomes to cut or shape bone. It delivers controlled force during operations, helping surgeons work on bone while limiting unnecessary injury to nearby tissues.

Mallet Finger

An injury to the extensor tendon at the distal finger joint, causing inability to actively straighten the fingertip. It may result from a forced flexion injury and sometimes includes an avulsion fracture.

Mallet Toe

A flexion deformity of the distal interphalangeal joint, causing the end of a lesser toe to bend downward. It may be flexible or rigid and can cause pain, rubbing, corns, or difficulty wearing shoes; it differs anatomically from hammertoe and claw toe.

Mallet Toe and Hammertoe

Two distinct toe deformities: mallet toe bends at the distal interphalangeal joint near the toenail, while hammertoe bends at the proximal interphalangeal joint in the middle of the toe. Either may cause rubbing, corns, or pain.

Mallet Toes

Alternate plural form; see *Mallet Toe*.

Malleus

The largest of the three small bones in the middle ear, also called the hammer. It is attached to the eardrum and passes sound vibrations to the incus and then the inner ear.

Common name: Hammer

Mallory Bodies

Irregular, ropey, eosinophilic cytoplasmic inclusions within degenerating hepatocytes composed of tangled, ubiquitinated cytokeratin intermediate filaments (cytokeratins 8 and 18), characteristically observed in alcoholic hepatitis, non-alcoholic steatohepatitis (MASH), and Wilson disease.

Alternate Names:
Mallory-Denk Bodies; Mallory Hyaline

Mallory Body

A clump of damaged proteins inside a liver cell, seen most often in alcohol-related liver disease but also in other liver conditions. It is a laboratory finding, not a diagnosis by itself.

Mallory-Weiss Syndrome

Non-transmural, longitudinal mucosal tears localized to the gastroesophageal junction or gastric cardia, typically provoked by severe, forceful retching, vomiting, or coughing, presenting clinically as acute upper gastrointestinal hemorrhage and hematemesis.

Alternate Names:
Mallory-Weiss Tear; Gastroesophageal Laceration

Mallory-Weiss Tear

A superficial tear in the lining of the lower esophagus or upper stomach, usually caused by forceful vomiting or retching. It commonly causes vomiting of blood. Many tears stop bleeding on their own within a few days, but upper endoscopy may be needed for diagnosis and treatment.

Malnutrition

Poor health caused by too little, too much, or an imbalance of nutrients. It can impair growth, immunity, wound healing, muscle function, and organ function and may involve undernutrition, nutrient deficiencies, or excess weight.

Malocclusion

A mismatch in the position of the upper and lower teeth or jaws that affects how the teeth meet. It may cause crowding, an overbite, an underbite, difficulty chewing, speech problems, jaw discomfort, or trouble cleaning the teeth.

Malocclusion and Orthodontics

Misalignment of the teeth or jaws and the dental treatment used to improve bite, spacing, function, or facial balance; see *Malocclusion*.

Malocclusion Of Teeth

Misalignment of the upper and lower teeth or jaws that affects the bite, chewing, speech, appearance, or oral hygiene.

Malondialdehyde

A chemical formed when fats are damaged by oxidation. Laboratory researchers may measure it as an indirect sign of oxidative stress, but the result alone does not diagnose a disease.

Malpighian Bodies

Renal glomeruli within Bowman's capsules, where

blood filtration begins; the term may also refer historically to lymphoid nodules in the spleen.

Malposition

An abnormal position of an organ, body part, implanted device, or fetus; in obstetrics, fetal malposition refers to an abnormal orientation of the presenting part during labor.

Malposition of the Uterus

A uterus tilted or oriented differently from the usual position, such as retroversion or retroflexion. It is often a normal variant, but pain, pressure, infertility, urinary symptoms, or a mass may indicate an underlying condition requiring evaluation.

Malpresentation

A fetal presentation other than the usual vertex presentation, including breech, face, brow, shoulder, or compound presentation. It may complicate labor and influence delivery planning.

Malrotation

Abnormal rotation or fixation of an organ during development, most often referring to abnormal rotation of the intestine and its risk of volvulus.

MALS

Abbreviation; see *Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome*.

Malta Fever

Brucellosis, a zoonotic infection caused by Brucella species and characterized by intermittent fever, sweats, fatigue, and joint or systemic symptoms.

Maltase

An intestinal enzyme that breaks maltose into two glucose molecules.

MALT Lymphoma

A usually slow-growing B-cell non-Hodgkin lymphoma arising from mucosa-associated lymphoid tissue, often in the stomach. It may occur in other organs and can be associated with chronic infection or autoimmune disease.

Alternate Names:
Extranodal Marginal Zone Lymphoma of Mucosa-Associated Lymphoid Tissue

Maltodextrin

A mixture of short glucose polymers produced by partial hydrolysis of starch, used as a rapidly digestible carbohydrate and as a thickener, filler, or carrier in foods and medicines.

Maltose

A reducing disaccharide composed of two glucose molecules joined by an alpha-1,4 glycosidic bond, produced during starch digestion and hydrolyzed by maltase.

Malt-Worker's Lung

An occupational hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhalation of organic dusts associated with malting or grain processing.

Mammaglobin A

A secretory protein expressed predominantly in mammary tissue and used as an immunohistochemical marker that can help identify breast origin in some metastatic carcinomas.

Mammaplasty

Surgery to change the size or shape of the breast or to rebuild it after breast removal. It may enlarge, reduce, lift, or reconstruct the breast; possible risks include bleeding, infection, altered sensation, scarring, and problems with healing.

Mammary

Relating to the breast or milk-producing gland. Mammary glands develop during puberty and pregnancy and produce milk after childbirth under hormone control. The term may describe normal breast tissue or diseases such as cysts, infection, benign growths, or breast cancer.

Mammary Duct Ectasia

Widening of milk ducts, usually those beneath the

nipple, often with thickened duct walls and material inside the ducts. It may cause nipple discharge, tenderness, nipple inversion, or a lump.

Alternate Names:
Duct Ectasia; Plasma Cell Mastitis; Comedomastitis

Mammary Epithelium

The epithelial lining of the mammary ducts and secretory alveoli; these cells help produce, secrete, and transport milk and can give rise to many breast carcinomas.

Mammary Gland

A specialized, hormone-responsive compound tubuloalveolar exocrine gland located in the subcutaneous tissue of the anterior thoracic wall overlying the pectoralis major and serratus anterior muscles, serving as the anatomical organ for lactation (breast milk synthesis and secretion). Composed of 15 to 20 independent glandular lobes radially arranged around the nipple-areolar complex, each drained by a major lactiferous duct that dilates into a lactiferous sinus beneath the areola before opening onto the nipple surface. Lobes are subdivided into functional terminal duct lobular units (TDLUs), embedded within dense fibrous interlobular connective tissue, suspensory ligaments of Cooper, and abundant adipose tissue. Glandular architecture and secretory function undergo dynamic cyclical changes governed by endocrine signaling: estrogen stimulates lactiferous ductal elongation; progesterone promotes alveolar budding and lobular development; prolactin drives milk protein and lipid biosynthesis; and oxytocin stimulates perialveolar myoepithelial cell contraction to mediate milk ejection (the let-down reflex). The mammary gland is the primary tissue of origin for benign lesions (fibroadenomas, cysts) and malignant neoplasms (ductal carcinoma in situ, invasive ductal carcinoma, and lobular carcinoma).

Mammary Glands

Plural form; see *Mammary Gland*.

Alternate Names:
Breasts; Lactiferous Glands

Mammary Implant

An artificial device placed in the breast for reconstruction or enlargement. Implants may contain saline or silicone gel and may be placed above or below the chest muscle. Possible complications include infection, rupture, hard scar tissue, changes in sensation, and rarely implant-associated lymphoma.

Mammary Paget Disease

Alternate name; see *Paget Disease Of The Breast*.

Mammary Paget's Disease

Alternate name; see *Paget Disease Of The Breast*.

Mammillary Bodies

A pair of small, spherical hypothalamic nuclei situated at the posterior termination of the anterior columns of the fornix on the ventral surface of the diencephalon, forming an essential component of the Papez circuit for memory consolidation; severely damaged in Wernicke encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Corpora Mamillaria

Mammillary Body

One of a pair of rounded nuclei on the underside of the hypothalamus that participate in memory circuits connecting the hippocampus with the thalamus; injury can contribute to memory impairment.

Mammogram

A mammogram is a low-dose x-ray examination of breast tissue used for screening and evaluation of masses, asymmetry, calcifications, or other abnormalities.

Mammographic Calcifications

Mineral deposits seen in breast tissue on a mammogram. Large deposits are usually noncancerous, while the shape and arrangement of very small deposits can be linked to early breast cancer or other changes and may lead to further imaging or biopsy.

Alternate Names:
Breast Calcifications

Mammography

X-ray imaging of the breast used to screen for or evaluate breast abnormalities. Screening intervals depend on age, risk, symptoms, and the guideline being followed. Standard views include the craniocaudal and mediolateral-oblique projections.

Mammoplasty

Plastic or reconstructive breast surgery that changes breast size, shape, or contour. It may reduce or enlarge the breasts, lift them, rebuild them after cancer surgery, or correct differences present from birth.

Management of Third-Stage Labor

Care from birth of the baby until delivery of the placenta, including monitoring, uterotonic medication when indicated, controlled cord traction by trained clinicians, and assessment for retained placenta or postpartum hemorrhage.

Mandatory Reporting

A legal or regulatory duty to report specified findings or circumstances—such as suspected child or elder abuse, certain communicable diseases, or some injuries—to designated authorities; requirements vary by jurisdiction.

Mandible

The large movable bone forming the lower face and holding the lower teeth. It supports chewing and speech and contains nerves and blood vessels that supply the teeth, gums, and lip.

Alternate Names:
Jawbone

Mandibular

Relating to the mandible, the lower jawbone. It holds the lower teeth and moves at the jaw joints. A mandibular fracture can cause pain, swelling, numbness, loose teeth, or a changed bite.

Mandibular Advancement Device

An oral appliance that holds the lower jaw or tongue forward during sleep to enlarge or stabilize the upper airway, usually for selected patients with obstructive sleep apnea or snoring.

Mandibular Ameloblastoma

An ameloblastoma arising in the lower jaw, usually a slow-growing locally invasive odontogenic tumor; see *Ameloblastoma*.

Mandibular Condyle

The rounded superior end of each mandibular ramus that articulates with the temporal bone at the temporomandibular joint and permits jaw movement.

Mandibular Fracture

A break in the lower jaw bone typically caused by trauma, presenting with pain, swelling, malocclusion, and difficulty opening the mouth; may require surgical fixation.

Mandibular Prosthesis

An artificial implant or device used to replace, reconstruct, stabilize, or restore part of the mandible after trauma, tumor removal, congenital deformity, or other loss of jaw structure.

Mandibulofacial Dysostosis

A congenital craniofacial disorder, classically Treacher Collins syndrome, involving underdevelopment of the mandible and cheekbones with variable abnormalities of the ears, eyes, and palate.

Manganese

An essential trace element required in small amounts. Excessive exposure, especially by inhalation, can injure the nervous system and cause manganism, a movement disorder resembling parkinsonism.

Mania

A distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood and increased energy or activity, with associated symptoms such as reduced need for sleep, rapid speech, racing thoughts, inflated self-esteem, or risky behavior. It causes marked impairment, requires hospitalization, or includes psychotic features; the episode usually lasts at least

one week when hospitalization is not required.

Manic

Relating to mania, a pathological episode of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood with increased energy or activity and associated changes in thought, speech, sleep, or judgment.

Manic-Depression

Older term; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Manic Depression in Children and Teens

Older name for bipolar disorder beginning in childhood or adolescence, involving episodes of mania, hypomania, or depression.

Manic-Depressive Disorder

Older name for bipolar disorder, characterized by episodes of mania or hypomania and episodes of depression; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Manic-Depressive Illness

Alternate name; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Manic Disorder

Alternate name; see *Bipolar Disorder*.

Manic Episode

A distinct period of abnormally elevated, expansive, or irritable mood and increased energy or activity, lasting at least seven days unless hospitalization is required sooner or psychotic features occur. It includes associated changes such as reduced need for sleep, rapid speech, racing thoughts, inflated self-esteem, or risky behavior and causes marked impairment.

Manic Mood

An abnormally elevated, expansive, or persistently irritable mood accompanied by increased energy or activity, reduced need for sleep, rapid speech, racing thoughts, inflated self-esteem, or risky behavior; it is characteristic of a manic episode.

Manifest

Clearly apparent or expressed; in clinical usage, a disease may manifest through particular signs or symptoms.

Manifestation

A sign, symptom, or other observable expression of a disease or health condition. Manifestations may be noticed by the person, found during examination, or detected through laboratory tests or imaging.

Manipulation

Deliberate physical movement of a body part or joint, often performed therapeutically or diagnostically by a trained clinician.

Manipulation Procedure

Deliberate movement of a body part by a trained clinician to restore motion, alignment, or function. It may be performed with or without anesthesia; soreness, bleeding, nerve injury, fracture, or worsening symptoms are possible depending on the procedure.

Mannan

A polysaccharide composed primarily of mannose units, found in the cell walls or capsules of many fungi and in some plants; fungal mannans can be recognized by the immune system and used in laboratory testing.

Mannheimia

A genus of gram-negative bacteria that mainly infects livestock, especially the respiratory tract of cattle and sheep.

Mannitol

A medicine that pulls water into the urine. It is given by injection in selected emergencies to reduce swelling or pressure around the brain or inside the eye and in some kidney-related situations; it can worsen dehydration or heart failure.

Mannose

A six-carbon monosaccharide related to glucose that

forms part of glycoproteins and glycolipids and is important in protein glycosylation and cell recognition.

Mannose-Binding Lectin Deficiency

Low levels or reduced activity of a blood protein that helps the immune system recognize and attack germs. Many people have no symptoms, but some are more prone to repeated infections, especially if other immune defenses are weak.

Mannosidosis

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient alpha-mannosidase activity, leading to accumulation of mannose-rich oligosaccharides and variable intellectual, skeletal, immune, hearing, and neurologic abnormalities.

Manometer

An instrument that measures pressure in a liquid or gas. In medicine, it may measure pressure in blood vessels, the lungs, the bladder, or another body space.

Manometry

A test that measures pressure and muscle coordination inside an organ or passage, such as the esophagus, stomach, rectum, or urinary tract. It helps identify movement and sphincter disorders.

Mansonella Perstans

A filarial worm that causes mansonellosis, usually acquired through bites of infected midges and often producing mild or no symptoms.

Mansonella Streptocerca

A filarial worm transmitted by biting midges that lives mainly in the skin and can cause itchy skin disease or small nodules.

Mansonelliasis

Infection with filarial nematodes of the genus *Mansonella*, transmitted by biting midges or blackflies; many infections are asymptomatic, but some cause itching, skin lesions, fever, or eosinophilia.

Mantle Cell Lymphoma

A usually fast-growing cancer of B lymphocytes that often enlarges lymph nodes and the spleen and may involve the bone marrow, blood, or digestive tract. A characteristic chromosome change helps confirm the diagnosis and guide treatment.

Mantle Field

A historical radiation-treatment field encompassing lymph-node regions in the neck, mediastinum, and upper chest, formerly used for Hodgkin lymphoma; modern treatment generally uses more limited involved-site fields.

Mantoux Test

A skin test for immune sensitization to tuberculosis. A small amount of purified protein derivative is injected into the forearm, and the raised area is measured 48 to 72 hours later; a positive result does not by itself prove active disease.

Manual

Performed by hand rather than automatically, or a written guide explaining procedures and instructions. In healthcare, manual techniques may assess, move, treat, or support body structures safely.

Manual Removal Of Placenta

A procedure in which a clinician removes a placenta that has not separated or cannot be delivered after birth. The timing and need depend on bleeding, maternal condition, and local clinical protocols.

Manual Therapy or Bodywork

Hands-on treatment involving mobilization, manipulation, massage, or soft-tissue techniques to address pain, stiffness, or movement limitations; risks and suitability depend on the condition and technique.

Manual Vacuum Aspiration

A procedure that uses a handheld syringe and a thin tube to remove tissue from the uterus. It may treat early pregnancy loss or end a pregnancy, depending on local law and clinical circumstances, and is performed by trained clinicians.

Alternate Names:
MVA; Mini-Suction Curettage

Manubrium

The broad, upper quadrangular segment of the sternum articulating superiorly with the clavicles (sternoclavicular joints) and first costal cartilages, and joining inferiorly with the sternal body at the sternal angle of Louis (level of T4-T5 intervertebral disc).

Alternate Names:
Manubrium Sterni

Manus

The hand, including the wrist and fingers, in anatomical terminology.

MAOIs

A class of medicines used mainly for depression and some other conditions. They slow the breakdown of certain brain chemical messengers and can have important interactions with foods and other medicines.

Map-Dot-Fingerprint Type Corneal Dystrophy

A usually bilateral corneal epithelial basement membrane dystrophy producing map-like, dot-like, or fingerprint-like patterns and sometimes recurrent corneal erosions or visual blurring.

Maple Syrup Urine Disease

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly break down three amino acids from protein. Harmful substances build up, causing sweet-smelling urine, poor feeding, sleepiness, abnormal movements, seizures, or brain injury without treatment.

Mapping

Charting the location of genes or other identifiable regions on chromosomes; the term may also describe charting functional or anatomical regions in other medical contexts.

Marantic

Relating to a sterile, noninfective process associated with wasting; marantic endocarditis refers to nonbacterial thrombotic endocarditis.

Marasmus

Severe undernutrition caused by prolonged lack of calories and protein. It leads to marked loss of body fat and muscle, poor growth in children, weakness, and increased vulnerability to infection.

Maraviroc

A CCR5 antagonist (entry inhibitor) used in combination antiretroviral therapy for HIV-1 infection in patients with CCR5-tropic virus. Maraviroc binds to the human CCR5 coreceptor on CD4+ T cells, preventing HIV-1 gp120 binding and viral entry.

Marble Bone Disease

Osteopetrosis, an inherited disorder of defective bone resorption causing abnormally dense but fragile bones and possible marrow failure.

Marburg Virus

A rare and highly lethal virus belonging to the filovirus family, closely related to the Ebola virus, that causes Marburg virus disease. It is a severe viral hemorrhagic fever transmitted to people from fruit bats and spread through contact with the body fluids of infected individuals. It causes sudden high fever, severe headache, muscle aches, widespread internal and external bleeding, and multi-organ failure.

Marburgvirus

Taxonomic genus; see *Marburg Virus*.

Marburg Virus Disease

A severe viral hemorrhagic fever caused by Marburg virus or Ravn virus. It usually begins abruptly with fever, headache, malaise, and muscle aches; gastrointestinal symptoms may follow, and severe disease can cause bleeding, shock, or organ failure. Infection can pass from fruit bats to people and between people through direct contact with infected blood or other body fluids.

Alternate Names:
Marburg Hemorrhagic Fever; MVD

Marcus Gunn Jaw-Winking Phenomenon

An uncommon congenital synkinetic neuro-ophthalmological anomaly characterized by unilateral upper eyelid retraction or elevation occurring synchronously with movements of the lower jaw (such as chewing, sucking, or lateral jaw excursion). Caused by aberrant congenital innervation of the ipsilateral levator palpebrae superioris muscle (cranial nerve III) by motor branches of the trigeminal nerve (cranial nerve V_3) supplying the pterygoid muscles.

Alternate Names:
Jaw-Winking Syndrome; Marcus Gunn Ptosis

Marcus Gunn Pupil

A relative afferent pupillary defect (RAPD) detected during the swinging-flashlight test, wherein the affected pupil displays paradoxical dilation (or reduced constriction) when the light source is shifted from the unaffected eye to the abnormal eye, indicating unilateral or asymmetric optic nerve or retinal pathology.

Alternate Names:
Relative Afferent Pupillary Defect; RAPD

Marden-Walker Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder characterized by a distinctive facial appearance, low muscle tone, limited joint movement, poor growth, and developmental delay. Care is supportive and involves several specialties.

Marek's Disease

A contagious herpesvirus disease of chickens that can cause nerve paralysis, tumors, weight loss, or death.

Marfanoid Habitus

A body build characterized by features such as tall stature, long limbs, long fingers (arachnodactyly), or joint laxity. It may occur in Marfan syndrome and other connective-tissue or metabolic disorders; body build alone does not establish or exclude Marfan syndrome.

Marfan's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Marfan Syndrome*.

Marfan Syndrome

An autosomal dominant connective-tissue disorder usually caused by a disease-causing variant in the *FBN1* gene, which encodes fibrillin-1. It may affect the aortic root and heart valves, eyes, skeleton, joints, lungs, and dura. Features can include aortic-root enlargement, lens dislocation, tall or long-limbed stature, long fingers, scoliosis, chest-wall differences, and joint laxity; the severity varies among individuals.

Marginal Cord Insertion

Attachment of the umbilical cord at or near the edge of the placental disk rather than toward its center. This differs from velamentous cord insertion, in which the umbilical vessels travel through the fetal membranes before reaching the placenta.

Alternate Names:
Battledore Placenta

Marginal Ulcer

An ulcer occurring at or near a gastrojejunal anastomosis, often after gastric bypass or other gastric surgery, where acid, ischemia, smoking, nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, or other factors may contribute.

Marginal Zone Lymphoma

A slow-growing non-Hodgkin lymphoma that begins in immune cells in the marginal zone of lymphoid tissue.

Alternate Names:
MZL

Maribavir

Maribavir is an antiviral medicine used to treat certain cytomegalovirus infections that are resistant or refractory to other treatment after transplantation.

Marie-Strumpell Disease

Ankylosing spondylitis, a chronic inflammatory disease primarily affecting the sacroiliac joints and

spine that can cause back pain, stiffness, and progressive spinal fusion.

Marijuana

Cannabis preparations containing cannabinoids such as THC; medical effects and risks depend on dose, formulation, route, and patient factors.

Alternate Names:
Cannabis; Weed; Pot

Marijuana/Cannabis

Cannabis is a plant containing active chemicals such as THC and cannabidiol. THC can affect memory, coordination, mood, and judgment; cannabis may also interact with medicines and can cause dependence.

Marijuana Intoxication

Temporary changes after using cannabis, including impaired attention, memory, coordination, judgment, or perception. Anxiety, panic, drowsiness, vomiting, or psychosis may occur. Severe symptoms or accidental ingestion by a child can be dangerous.

Marijuana Substance Use

Marijuana or cannabis can impair attention, memory, coordination, and driving and may cause dependence, anxiety, psychosis, or respiratory harm when smoked.

Marine Animal Stings Or Bites

Injuries caused by marine animals through biting, stinging, spines, or venom; effects range from local pain and swelling to allergic, neurologic, or systemic toxicity.

Marine Toxin

A poisonous substance produced or accumulated by marine organisms, such as some fish, shellfish, algae, or bacteria, that can cause neurologic, gastrointestinal, or other poisoning.

Marital Disharmony

Persistent conflict or distress in a marriage or partnership that may contribute to psychological symptoms or require relationship-focused support.

Marital Status

A demographic or social-status variable describing whether a person is unmarried, married or partnered, separated, divorced, widowed, or in another legally or culturally recognized relationship; it may be relevant to social and health assessments.

Marital Therapy

Counseling for couples that addresses communication, conflict, emotional distress, intimacy, and relationship problems. It may help partners improve interaction and make informed decisions about their relationship.

Marjolin Ulcer

A rare, aggressive cutaneous squamous cell carcinoma arising within longstanding chronic nonhealing wounds, burn scars (cicatrices), chronic venous stasis ulcers, or chronic osteomyelitis sinus tracts.

Alternate Names:
Scar Carcinoma; Burn Scar Squamous Cell Carcinoma

Marked

An adjective in clinical reports indicating that a finding is pronounced or substantial. It has no universal numerical threshold; its degree is judged against the scale or reference used for that finding.

Marker

An identifiable biological feature used to track a gene, cell, disease, or process; a genetic marker is a detectable DNA region inherited with a nearby gene, while a blood or tumor marker is a measurable substance associated with a condition.

Maroteaux-Lamy Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which certain complex sugars build up in the body. It can cause short stature, stiff joints, enlarged liver or spleen, cloudy corneas, heart-valve disease, breathing problems, and coarse facial features. Intelligence is often normal. Treatment may include enzyme replacement,

supportive care, or stem-cell transplantation.

Alternate Names:
Mucopolysaccharidosis Type Vi; MPS VI; Arylsulfatase B Deficiency

Marrow

The soft tissue inside bones, including red marrow that produces blood cells and yellow marrow rich in fat.

Marrow Hyperplasia

Increased activity and numbers of blood-forming cells in the bone marrow. It may occur when the body is replacing blood lost or destroyed, or when tissues are not receiving enough oxygen.

Marshall Syndrome

A rare periodic-fever syndrome, usually associated with PFAPA features, including recurrent fever, aphthous ulcers, pharyngitis, and cervical adenitis, often beginning in childhood.

Marsupialization

A surgical technique that opens a cyst or abscess and sutures its edges to the surrounding skin or mucosa to permit continuing drainage.

Martin-Bell Syndrome

An older name for fragile X syndrome, an inherited neurodevelopmental disorder caused by CGG-repeat expansion in the FMR1 gene.

Martinus Beijerinck

A Dutch microbiologist who helped establish the concept of viruses as infectious agents that reproduce only in living cells and contributed to the development of enrichment culture methods.

MASA Syndrome

An X-linked neurodevelopmental disorder characterized by intellectual disability, absent or limited speech, shuffling gait, spasticity, and adducted or clasped thumbs; it may also include short stature and lumbar lordosis. The name is an older acronym; the condition is also called L1 syndrome.

Masculinization

Development of male-typical physical characteristics, caused by normal puberty, androgen excess, androgen treatment, or certain disorders.

MASH

Abbreviation; see *Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis*.

Mask

A covering placed over the face to deliver or filter gases or to protect the wearer or others from droplets or particles. Medical masks include oxygen masks, anesthesia masks, noninvasive-ventilation masks, and surgical masks; the specific type determines its function.

Masked Data

Data altered, obscured, or replaced so that identifying values or sensitive details are hidden while selected analytical properties may be retained; masking is used to protect privacy and can be reversible or irreversible.

Masklike Face

An expressionless face with little spontaneous animation, also called masklike facies; it may occur in Parkinson disease, myotonic dystrophy, and other disorders.

MASLD

Abbreviation; see *Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease*.

Masochism

Sexual or nonsexual arousal or gratification associated with receiving pain, humiliation, or degradation; distress or impairment determines clinical significance.

Mason Classification

A system for classifying radial head fractures. Type I is nondisplaced; Type II is a displaced partial-head fracture; and Type III is a comminuted fracture involving the head. The Mason–Johnston modi-

fication adds Type IV for a radial head fracture associated with elbow dislocation.

Alternate Names:
Mason–Johnston Classification

Masoprocol

A synthetic derivative of nordihydroguaiaretic acid that inhibits lipoxygenase pathways and has been investigated for topical treatment of actinic keratoses and for antineoplastic activity.

Mass

A lump or localized area of abnormal tissue detected by examination or imaging. It may be benign, malignant, or caused by inflammation or another process; the word alone does not specify its cause or behavior.

Massage

Manual manipulation of soft tissues using techniques such as stroking, kneading, or pressure, used for relaxation or symptom relief; it is not a substitute for diagnosis or treatment of an underlying disease.

Massage Therapy

Massage therapy uses hands-on manipulation of soft tissues to promote relaxation or help manage selected pain and movement problems.

Mass Casualty Incident

An event causing more injured or ill people than nearby medical services can immediately manage. Health teams use triage to prioritize urgent treatment, transport, and limited supplies.

Masseter

A powerful muscle of chewing that elevates the mandible and lies over the lateral surface of the mandibular ramus.

Masseter Muscle

A strong chewing muscle running from the cheekbone to the lower jaw. It raises the jaw to close the mouth and may become painful or enlarged with teeth grinding.

Massive Hemoptysis

Life-threatening coughing of blood that threatens the airway, breathing, or circulation; a fixed volume threshold is not required. Management focuses on airway stabilization and control of the bleeding source.

Massive Ovarian Edema

Marked stromal edema causing enlargement of one or both ovaries, usually due to partial torsion or hormonal stimulation. It can mimic an ovarian neoplasm and may cause pain or virilization.

Massive Pulmonary Embolism

A high-risk, life-threatening pulmonary embolism characterized by extensive clot obstruction causing acute right ventricular strain and hemodynamic collapse (systolic blood pressure < 90 mmHg or obstructive shock). See *Massive Pulmonary Embolus*.

Massive Pulmonary Embolus

A severe blockage of the main blood vessels to the lungs by a blood clot. It can suddenly strain or stop the right side of the heart and cause very low blood pressure, severe breathlessness, fainting, bluish skin, or cardiac arrest. Treatment may include clot-dissolving medicine or removal of the clot.

Alternate Names:
Massive PE; High-Risk Pulmonary Embolism; Fulminant Pulmonary Embolism

Massive Transfusion Protocol

A coordinated protocol for life-threatening hemorrhage that provides rapid, balanced delivery of red cells, plasma, and platelets with monitoring and correction of fibrinogen, calcium, temperature, and acid-base abnormalities.

Mass Screening

Testing a large group of people who do not yet have symptoms to find disease or risk early. Screening programs are evaluated by test performance, follow-up pathways, benefits, and harms.

Mass Spectrometer

A laboratory instrument that identifies chemicals by giving their particles an electrical charge and separating them according to size and charge. It can measure medicines, toxins, proteins, and other substances.

Mass Spectrometry

An analytical method that identifies and measures molecules by their mass-to-charge ratios; coupled with chromatography, it is widely used in clinical chemistry, toxicology, pharmacology, and proteomics.

Mastalgia

Breast pain or tenderness, which may be cyclical with menstruation or noncyclical. Causes include hormonal changes, cysts, infection, trauma, and musculoskeletal pain.

Mast Cell

An immune cell found in tissues that releases substances involved in allergy, inflammation, and defense against some germs. Its products can cause itching, swelling, mucus production, and changes in blood pressure.

Mast Cell Activation Syndrome

A disorder causing recurrent episodes of mast-cell mediator symptoms in at least two organ systems, such as hives, flushing, abdominal symptoms, wheezing, or low blood pressure. Diagnosis also requires an event-related rise in a validated mediator, often tryptase, and a response to treatment that blocks mast-cell mediators or activation.

Mast Cell Sarcoma

A very rare, aggressive cancer of mast cells, immune cells involved in allergic reactions. It forms a destructive growth in tissue or bone. Unlike systemic mastocytosis, it is characterized by a localized sarcomatous tumor and may progress to disseminated mast-cell disease or acute leukemia. Clinical manifestations depend on the involved site and may include pain, swelling, organ dysfunction, or mediator-related symptoms such as flushing and hypotension. Diagnosis requires histopathology, mast-cell immunophenotyping, and systemic staging; management generally involves specialist-directed intensive antineoplastic therapy.

Mast-Cell Sarcoma

Alternate spelling; see *Mast Cell Sarcoma*.

Mastectomy

Surgery to remove breast tissue from one or both breasts, usually to treat or prevent selected breast cancers. Most mastectomies remove nearly all breast tissue; whether the nipple, areola, skin, or nearby lymph nodes are removed depends on the type. A lumpectomy removes a tumor or abnormal area while leaving most of the breast in place.

Masticate

To chew food, using the teeth, tongue, and muscles of mastication to mechanically break it down and mix it with saliva before swallowing.

Mastication

Chewing food with the teeth and moving it with the tongue before swallowing. It breaks food into smaller pieces and mixes it with saliva, making it easier to swallow and begin digesting.

Masticatory Muscle

One of the muscles that moves the mandible during chewing, chiefly the masseter, temporalis, medial pterygoid, and lateral pterygoid muscles.

Mastitis

Inflammation of breast tissue, often occurring during lactation but also possible outside lactation. It may cause localized pain, warmth, swelling, redness, or fever. It may be infectious or noninfectious.

Alternate Names:
Breast Inflammation

Mastocytoma

A localized collection or tumor of mast cells, usually presenting in the skin as a solitary cutaneous mastocytoma; rubbing the lesion can cause itching,

redness, or swelling from mediator release.

Mastocytosis

A disorder in which too many mast cells, immune cells involved in allergic reactions, collect in the skin or internal organs. It may cause itchy spots, flushing, abdominal symptoms, wheezing, or low blood pressure.

Mastodynia

Pain or tenderness in one or both breasts, also called mastalgia. It may follow the menstrual cycle or result from injury, infection, medicines, cysts, or other breast conditions; a new persistent lump, skin change, or bloody discharge may indicate another breast problem.

Mastoid

Relating to the mastoid part of the temporal bone behind the ear. This area contains air spaces connected with the middle ear and can become infected, causing pain, swelling, or drainage.

Mastoid Antrum

An air-containing cavity in the mastoid portion of the temporal bone that communicates with the middle-ear attic.

Mastoid Bone

The portion of the temporal bone located behind the ear.

Mastoidectomy

Surgery to remove infected or diseased air cells in the bone behind the ear. It may treat chronic middle-ear infection, cholesteatoma, mastoiditis, or complications that have spread beyond the ear.

Mastoiditis

Infection of the bone behind the ear, usually spreading from a middle-ear infection. It can cause pain, redness, swelling behind the ear, fever, or the ear sticking out, and may spread to nearby areas.

Mastoid Process

The conical bony projection of the temporal bone behind the ear, containing air cells and providing attachment for several neck muscles; infection of its air cells is mastoiditis.

Mastopexy

Breast-lift surgery that removes extra skin and reshapes breast tissue to raise the breasts and nipples. It can improve shape but does not necessarily reduce breast size; scars, altered sensation, asymmetry, and changes in breastfeeding ability are possible risks.

Alternate Names:
Breast Lift

Masturbation

Self-stimulation of the genitals for sexual pleasure. It is a common human behavior; it is generally not harmful unless it causes injury, distress, or interferes with daily life.

Alternate Names:
Autoeroticism; Solitary Sex

Materia Medica

An older term for the body of medicinal substances and information about their properties and uses.

Maternal

Maternal means relating to a mother or the pregnant person, especially in connection with pregnancy, childbirth, or postpartum health.

Maternal Age

Maternal age is the age of the pregnant person and can influence fertility, pregnancy risks, screening choices, and obstetric care.

Maternal Anemia

A reduction in circulating maternal hemoglobin concentrations below gestational norms (typically < 11 g/dL in the first and third trimesters), most commonly resulting from iron deficiency or plasma volume expansion; see *Anemia*.

Maternal Expulsive Efforts

The pregnant person's efforts to push the baby down and out during the second stage of labor. Pushing may follow the body's urge or be guided by the birth team, depending on the situation and chosen pain relief.

Alternate Names:
Bearing Down; Second Stage Expulsive Efforts

Maternal Hemorrhage

Excessive, potentially life-threatening blood loss during pregnancy, labor, or the postpartum period; see *Antepartum Hemorrhage* and *Postpartum Hemorrhage*.

Maternal-Fetal Medicine

The obstetric subspecialty concerned with pregnancies involving increased risk to the pregnant person or fetus. It includes care related to maternal medical disorders, pregnancy complications, fetal growth or structural conditions, and prenatal diagnosis, often in coordination with other specialties.

Maternal Health

The physical and mental health of a person during pregnancy, childbirth, and the postpartum period. Care includes prevention, antenatal monitoring, safe delivery, and treatment of complications.

Maternal Mortality

Death during pregnancy or within 42 days after pregnancy ends from a cause related to or worsened by pregnancy or its management, excluding accidental or incidental causes. It is measured as a population health indicator; deaths later in the first postpartum year are classified separately as late maternal deaths.

Maternal Mortality Rate

The number of maternal deaths in a specified period relative to the population of women of reproductive age, commonly expressed per 100,000 women per year. It differs from the maternal mortality ratio, which uses live births as its denominator.

Maternal Obesity

Obesity present before or during pregnancy. It can increase the risk of high blood pressure, diabetes, cesarean birth, and health problems for the pregnant person or baby.

Maternal Physiologic Changes In Pregnancy

Normal body changes during pregnancy that support the growing fetus and prepare for birth. They affect blood volume, heart function, breathing, digestion, kidneys, hormones, breasts, skin, and the musculoskeletal system.

Maternal Sepsis

Organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated maternal response to infection during pregnancy, childbirth, or the postpartum period. It may arise from uterine, urinary, respiratory, wound, or other infection and requires prompt cultures, antimicrobial therapy, source control, and hemodynamic support.

Maternal Serum Alpha-Fetoprotein

A blood test during pregnancy, usually at 15–20 weeks, that measures a protein made by the fetus. An unusually high or low result may be linked to an incorrect pregnancy date, more than one fetus, or certain birth defects or chromosome conditions. It is a screening test, not a diagnosis; abnormal results may lead to additional testing.

Maternal Vaccine

A vaccine given during pregnancy to protect the pregnant person and, through transferred antibodies, provide early protection to the fetus or newborn; recommended products and timing depend on current guidance.

Maternity

The state or service relating to pregnancy, childbirth, and the care of the mother and newborn.

Maternity Services

Healthcare for pregnancy, labor and birth, the postpartum period, and the newborn. Services may include prenatal checks, midwifery or obstetric care,

delivery support, breastfeeding help, and emergency care.

Materteral

Relating to a maternal aunt or to the genetic relationship between an aunt and her niece or nephew; synonymous with materterine.

Mathematics Disorder

A learning disorder involving persistent difficulty understanding numbers, calculation, quantity, or mathematical reasoning despite appropriate instruction.

Mating

Sexual pairing or reproduction between organisms that permits exchange or transfer of gametes and may lead to fertilization.

Matrix Band

A thin dental strip placed around a prepared tooth to temporarily replace a missing wall and contain restorative material while a filling or crown buildup is formed.

Matrix Metalloproteinase

An enzyme that cuts proteins in the extracellular matrix surrounding cells. It helps with normal tissue repair and remodeling, but excessive or poorly controlled activity can promote inflammation, tissue destruction, or cancer spread.

Maturation

The process through which cells, tissues, organs, or a person develop and become fully functional. Normal maturation may involve changes in size, structure, ability, hormone activity, and response to the environment.

Maturation Disorders Of Erythropoiesis

Anemia categories caused by ineffective development or maturation of red-cell precursors in the bone marrow. They include disorders of hemoglobin synthesis, such as iron deficiency and thalassemia, and disorders of nuclear maturation, such as vitamin B12 or folate deficiency and myelodysplasia.

Mature Onset Diabetes

Older term; see *Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus*.

Mature Teratoma

A germ-cell tumor composed of well-differentiated tissues from one or more embryonic germ layers; many are benign, but behavior depends on the site, age, and tumor type, and some can undergo malignant transformation.

Maxilla

The paired bones forming the upper jaw and supporting the upper teeth. They also form parts of the cheeks, nose, eye sockets, hard palate, and the air-filled sinuses behind the cheeks.

Maxillary

Relating to the maxilla, the upper jawbone. It supports the upper teeth, forms part of the eye socket and roof of the mouth, and contains the maxillary sinuses. Problems may include tooth infection, sinusitis, or facial fractures.

Maxillary Sinus

The maxillary sinus is a paired, air-filled cavity in the maxilla beneath each orbit. It drains into the nasal cavity and may become inflamed or infected in sinusitis.

Maxillary Sinusitis

Inflammation or infection of the air-filled spaces behind the cheekbones. It may cause cheek or tooth pain, blocked nose, thick nasal discharge, reduced smell, cough, or fever and can follow a cold, allergy, or dental infection.

Maxillofacial

Relating to the jaw, face, mouth, and associated bones and soft tissues. Maxillofacial care may include treatment of injuries, congenital differences, infections, and tumors.

Maxillofacial Prosthesis

An artificial replacement for part of the face, jaw, mouth, nose, eye area, or ear after injury, cancer surgery, or a birth difference. Examples include devices that close a palate opening or replace an eye, nose, or ear.

Maxillofacial Reconstruction

Reconstructive surgery of the jaws, face, mouth, or associated soft tissues after trauma, cancer removal, congenital difference, infection, or severe tissue loss. Reconstruction may use bone or soft-tissue grafts, local or free flaps, implants, and staged procedures.

Maximal Breathing Capacity

The greatest volume of air that can be moved in and out of the lungs in a specified period during maximal effort; it is related to but distinct from standard spirometric measures.

Maximum

The maximum is the greatest value in a set of measurements or the highest level reached by a variable, such as a recorded temperature, blood pressure, or drug concentration.

Maximum Plasma Concentration

The highest measured plasma concentration after a dose. Cmax and the time to reach it are used to describe absorption rate, peak-related toxicity, and comparative pharmacokinetics.

Alternate Names:
Cmax

Maximum Thickness

Maximum thickness is the greatest measured thickness of a structure or specimen. It may be reported in imaging, pathology, or assessment of a lesion, organ, or tissue layer.

Maximum Tolerated Dose

The highest dose of a drug that produces acceptable, manageable toxicity without causing unacceptable adverse effects, determined through dose-escalation studies, most commonly in Phase I clinical trials. The MTD identifies the dose range for subsequent efficacy studies.

Mayer-Rokitansky-Kuster-Hauser Syndrome

A congenital condition in which the uterus, cervix, and upper part of the vagina are absent or underdeveloped. Ovarian function and puberty usually develop normally, but menstruation does not occur because the uterus is absent or very small. Kidney, skeletal, or hearing differences may also occur.

Alternate Names:
MRKH Syndrome; Müllerian Agenesis

Mayer-Rokitansky-Küster-Hauser Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Mayer-Rokitansky-Kuster-Hauser Syndrome*.

May-Hegglin Anomaly

An inherited MYH9-related disorder with macrothrombocytopenia, giant platelets, and characteristic leukocyte inclusions; hearing, kidney, or cataract abnormalities may occur.

Mayo Scissors

Strong surgical scissors designed to cut fascia, muscle, sutures, and other tough materials. Their broad blades provide force and control, and they may be straight or curved for different surgical tasks.

Maytansine

Maytansine is a potent antimitotic compound that binds tubulin and inhibits microtubule assembly. Its derivatives are used as cytotoxic payloads in some antibody–drug conjugates.

May-Thurner Syndrome

Compression of the left pelvic vein by the right pelvic artery, which can slow blood flow and increase the risk of a clot or swelling in the left leg.

Maze Procedure

A heart operation for atrial fibrillation. The surgeon creates carefully placed lines of scar tissue in the

upper heart chambers to block abnormal electrical signals and help restore a regular rhythm. It may be performed with other heart surgery; recurrence, bleeding, stroke, or the need for a pacemaker are possible.

Alternate Names:
Cox-Maze Procedure; Surgical Ablation for Atrial Fibrillation; Maze Operation

Maze Surgery

A surgical procedure for selected atrial fibrillation in which lines of scar are created in the atria to block abnormal electrical circuits and guide impulses along a controlled pathway.

Mazindol

Mazindol is a sympathomimetic appetite suppressant that affects central catecholamine signaling. It has been used for short-term obesity treatment in some countries and may cause stimulant-related adverse effects.

MB ChB

Abbreviation for Bachelor of Medicine and Bachelor of Surgery, a medical degree awarded in many countries.

MCAD Deficiency

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot break down medium-chain fats for energy, especially during fasting or illness. It can cause hypoketotic hypoglycemia, vomiting, lethargy, seizures, or liver problems and is caused by variants in *ACADM*.

MCA Peak Systolic Velocity

An ultrasound measurement of blood speed in a major artery of the fetus's brain. An unusually high value may suggest fetal anemia and can help guide monitoring or further testing during pregnancy.

McArdle Disease

A rare inherited muscle disorder in which muscles cannot release usable energy from stored sugar during exercise. Activity can cause early muscle pain, cramps, exhaustion, or dangerous muscle breakdown with dark urine. Some people improve after slowing down briefly and restarting gently, called the second-wind phenomenon. Avoiding sudden strenuous exercise helps prevent attacks.

Alternate Names:
GSD V; Myophosphorylase Deficiency; Glycogen Storage Disease Type V

McBurney Point

A surface landmark about one-third of the distance from the right anterior superior iliac spine to the umbilicus, near where the appendix joins the cecum. Tenderness there may occur with appendicitis, but the appendix position and site of greatest tenderness vary.

Alternate Names:
McBurney's Point; Appendiceal Surface Landmark

McBurney Sign

Tenderness at McBurney's point in the right lower abdomen. It can support suspicion of appendicitis but is not diagnostic by itself; appendicitis is inflammation of the appendix and is not necessarily caused by infection.

McBurney's Point

A location in the lower-right abdomen where tenderness may occur when the appendix is inflamed. Pain there can support a diagnosis of appendicitis but cannot confirm it by itself.

Mcc Gene

A gene that helps regulate cell growth and is considered a tumour-suppressor gene. Loss or alteration of its function has been found in some colorectal and other cancers, but the finding alone does not diagnose cancer.

McCune-Albright Syndrome

A mosaic disorder caused by a postzygotic activating variant in *GNAS*. It can affect bone, skin, and hormone-producing organs, causing fibrous dysplasia, café-au-lait skin macules, and hormone excess such as early puberty; the features vary with the tissues involved.

McDonald Cerclage

A common operation that places a strong stitch around the cervix through the vagina. It may help keep the cervix closed when there is a high risk of very early birth; timing and suitability depend on the pregnancy history and examination.

MCH

The average amount of hemoglobin in one red blood cell, reported in a complete blood count. Hemoglobin carries oxygen, and the result helps classify some types of anemia.

MCHC

The average concentration of hemoglobin inside red blood cells, reported in a complete blood count. It helps clinicians assess and classify anemia together with the other blood-count results.

MCL Injury

Abbreviation; see *Medial Collateral Ligament Injury*.

MC Lymphoma

Abbreviation; see *Mantle Cell Lymphoma*.

McMurray Test

A knee examination in which the leg is flexed, rotated, and extended to place stress on the menisci. Pain or a palpable click may suggest a meniscal lesion but is not diagnostic alone.

McRoberts Maneuver

A positioning maneuver for managing shoulder dystocia where the mother's legs are hyperflexed onto her abdomen, with thighs against the abdomen. This flattens the sacrum, increases the anteroposterior diameter of the pelvis, and rotates the symphysis pubis superiorly. Often combined with suprapubic pressure.

MCRPC

Abbreviation; see *Metastatic Castration-Resistant Prostate Cancer*.

MCV

Mean corpuscular volume: the calculated average volume of a red blood cell, derived from hematocrit and red-cell count and reported as part of a complete blood count.

MDMA

3,4-Methylenedioxymethamphetamine, a psychoactive stimulant and hallucinogen commonly known as ecstasy or molly; it can produce serious cardiovascular, neurologic, and temperature-regulation effects.

MDMA Toxicity

Serotonergic and sympathomimetic toxicity from MDMA, with agitation, hyperthermia, diaphoresis, tachycardia, hypertension, jaw clenching, seizures, rhabdomyolysis, and potentially severe hyponatremia from excess water intake. Treatment includes rapid cooling, benzodiazepines, electrolyte assessment, and careful management of complications.

MDS

Abbreviation; see *Myelodysplastic Neoplasms*.

Mead Acid

An omega-9 fatty acid made when the body lacks enough essential omega-6 and omega-3 fatty acids. Increased levels can support laboratory assessment of essential-fatty-acid deficiency, although results must be interpreted with nutrition and illness history.

Meadow Saffron

Colchicum autumnale, a plant containing colchicine; ingestion can cause severe gastrointestinal illness, multiorgan toxicity, and death.

Mean

The mean is the arithmetic average, calculated by adding all values and dividing by the number of values. It is commonly used to summarize clinical measurements but can be distorted by extreme values.

Mean Arterial Pressure

An estimate of the average pressure pushing blood through the body's organs during each heartbeat. Clinicians use it with other findings to judge whether organs are receiving enough blood.

Mean Cell Volume

The average volume of a red blood cell, calculated from the hematocrit and red-cell count and reported as MCV in a complete blood count.

Mean Corpuscular Hemoglobin Concentration

The average concentration of oxygen-carrying hemoglobin inside red blood cells. It is part of a complete blood count and helps classify the cause of anemia.

Mean Corpuscular Volume

The average size of red blood cells, reported in a complete blood count. Small cells or large cells can point toward different causes of anemia; significance depends on the other blood results.

Mean Diameter

The average diameter of a structure or lesion, usually calculated from one or more measured dimensions. Measurement methods can differ when clinical measurements are compared.

Mean Thickness

Mean thickness is the average thickness calculated from multiple measurements of a tissue, structure, or specimen. It is used in imaging, pathology, and physiologic measurements.

Measles

An acute, highly contagious respiratory infection caused by measles virus. It typically causes fever, cough, runny nose, conjunctivitis, and sometimes Koplik spots, followed by a maculopapular rash that spreads from the face downward. Complications include pneumonia and encephalitis.

Measles Infection

Alternate name; see *Measles*.

Measles Virus

An enveloped, negative-sense single-stranded RNA virus in the genus *Morbillivirus* that causes measles. It spreads through the air and can cause fever, cough, runny nose, conjunctivitis, and rash.

Measurable Residual Disease

Cancer cells that remain after treatment and can be detected with a sensitive, validated test. The amount may be too small to see on scans or by routine examination, but it can help estimate relapse risk and guide further treatment.

Measurement

Measurement is the quantitative determination of a physical, biologic, or clinical characteristic using a defined method and unit. Interpretation depends on accuracy, precision, and the clinical context.

Meatal

Relating to a meatus, a natural opening or passage in the body. It commonly refers to the opening of the urethra, the ear canal, or one of the passages inside the nose. Meatal narrowing can obstruct urine or air flow.

Meatal Stenosis

Narrowing of the urethral meatus, which may cause a deflected or narrow urinary stream, spraying, dysuria, or difficulty emptying the bladder.

Meatus

A natural anatomical opening, orifice, or canal-like passage leading into or communicating with an interior body cavity or tubular organ. Major clinical examples include: (1) The External acoustic meatus (ear canal, conducting acoustic sound waves from the auricle to the tympanic membrane); (2) The External urethral meatus (the terminal slit-like opening of the urethra on the glans penis in males or in the vulval vestibule in females; meatal stenosis can cause obstructive voiding symptoms); and (3) The Nasal meatuses (superior, middle, and inferior

nasal meatuses, cleft-like passages situated beneath the corresponding nasal conchae/turbinates in the lateral nasal wall that receive ostial drainage from the paranasal sinuses and nasolacrimal duct).

Meatuses

Plural form; see *Meatus*.

Mebendazole

A medicine used to treat several intestinal worm infections. It disrupts structures the worms need to absorb nutrients and survive; treatment choices and dosing depend on the parasite, age, pregnancy, and local guidance.

Mebrofenin Scan

A nuclear-medicine scan that follows a tracer through the liver and bile ducts. It can assess gallbladder function, bile blockage, leaks, or selected causes of jaundice and abdominal pain.

Mecamylamine

Mecamylamine is an orally active ganglionic nicotinic-receptor blocker that reduces sympathetic nerve transmission and lowers blood pressure. It has been used for severe hypertension and may cause postural hypotension, dizziness, constipation, and dry mouth.

Mecarzole

Mecarzole is a synonym for carbendazim, a benzimidazole fungicide that interferes with fungal microtubule formation. It is an agricultural chemical rather than a routine human medicine and may be toxic if exposure occurs.

ME/CFS

Abbreviation; see *Myalgic Encephalomyelitis*.

Mechanical Circulatory Support

Machines or pumps that help the heart move blood when it cannot pump enough on its own. They may be used temporarily during severe illness or longer term while awaiting, or instead of, a heart transplant.

Mechanical Insufflation-Exsufflation

A cough-assist device that gives a breath in followed quickly by suction-like pressure out. It helps people with weak breathing muscles clear mucus, especially in neuromuscular disease or spinal-cord injury.

Mechanical Ventilation

Breathing support from a machine that pushes air and oxygen into the lungs and helps remove carbon dioxide. It may be delivered through a mask or a breathing tube when illness or injury prevents adequate breathing.

Mechanical Ventilator

A mechanical ventilator is a machine that supports or replaces spontaneous breathing by delivering controlled or assisted breaths, usually through a mask or an endotracheal tube. Settings are adjusted to oxygenation, ventilation, mechanics, and patient needs.

Mechanism Of Death

The nonspecific physiologic or biochemical failure through which a disease or injury causes death, such as respiratory failure, fatal arrhythmia, exsanguination, or cardiac tamponade. It is distinct from the underlying cause of death and the manner of death; conditions such as sepsis are generally recorded as causes, not mechanisms.

Mechanism Of Toxicity

The way a substance causes injury or illness in the body. It may interfere with an enzyme or receptor, damage cell membranes or DNA, disrupt energy production, or trigger an abnormal immune response. Understanding the mechanism helps guide prevention and treatment.

Mechanoreceptor

A sensory receptor that detects physical forces such as touch, pressure, stretch, vibration, sound, or movement. It converts mechanical stimulation into electrical signals carried by nerves to the brain or spinal cord.

Mechlorethamine

Mechlorethamine is an alkylating antineoplastic agent that cross-links DNA and inhibits cell division. Topical gel is used for cutaneous T-cell lymphoma; systemic use is limited by toxicities such as myelosuppression and tissue injury.

Meckel Diverticulectomy

Surgical removal of a Meckel diverticulum, usually performed when it causes bleeding, inflammation, obstruction, perforation, or is found incidentally in a high-risk setting.

Meckel Diverticulum

A small pouch present from birth on the lower small intestine, caused by a remnant of the embryonic vitelline duct. It often causes no symptoms, but can bleed, become inflamed, or cause bowel obstruction or, rarely, volvulus. A Meckel scan can help detect ectopic gastric tissue in selected children with unexplained gastrointestinal bleeding; treatment depends on symptoms and complications.

Alternate Names:
Meckel's Diverticulum; Omphalomesenteric Diverticulum; Congenital Ileal Diverticulum

Meckel-Gruber Syndrome

A severe inherited birth disorder that causes major abnormalities of the brain, kidneys, and limbs. Typical findings include a sac of brain tissue at the back of the skull, enlarged cystic kidneys, and extra fingers or toes. Poor lung development is common, and the condition is usually fatal before or shortly after birth.

Alternate Names:
Meckel Syndrome; Dysencephalia Splanchnocystica

Meckel's Diverticulum

Alternate name; see *Meckel Diverticulum*.

Meclizine

Meclizine is a first-generation antihistamine with anticholinergic and vestibular-suppressant effects. It is used to prevent or treat motion sickness and vertigo and may cause drowsiness, dry mouth, and blurred vision.

Meclofenamate Overdose

Taking too much meclofenamate, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug, may cause nausea, vomiting, stomach pain or bleeding, drowsiness, kidney injury, seizures, or metabolic acidosis. Severe poisoning can be life-threatening.

Meconium

The thick, dark first stool of a newborn, composed of intestinal secretions, shed cells, mucus, and swallowed amniotic material.

Meconium Aspiration

Breathing meconium, a newborn's first stool, into the airways before or around birth. It can block airflow and inflame the lungs, causing breathing difficulty and low oxygen.

Meconium Aspiration Syndrome

Breathing problems in a newborn after meconium, the first stool, enters the airways before or during birth. It can block airways and inflame the lungs, causing rapid breathing, low oxygen, and need for respiratory support.

Meconium Ileus

A newborn intestinal obstruction caused by unusually thick, sticky meconium (the first stool) blocking the terminal ileum, the last part of the small intestine. It is strongly associated with cystic fibrosis and may cause abdominal swelling, green (bilious) vomiting, and delayed passage of stool; severe cases can lead to twisting or perforation of the intestine.

Meconium Peritonitis

Inflammation of the tissue lining a fetus's abdomen after a hole in the intestine allows first stool to escape before birth. It can cause abdominal fluid or calcium deposits and may be linked to bowel blockage or cystic fibrosis.

Meconium-Stained Amniotic Fluid

Green or yellow amniotic fluid caused by passage of fetal stool before birth. It may occur with a mature or distressed fetus and increases the risk of breathing problems after delivery; newborns are

assessed and supported as needed.

MECP2 Duplication Syndrome

A rare X-linked genetic disorder caused by extra copies or increased dosage of the MECP2 gene. It often causes developmental delay, low muscle tone, seizures, recurrent infections, and breathing or feeding problems, especially in boys.

Medial

Medial means toward or situated nearer the body's midline; it contrasts with lateral and is used to describe anatomical position, movement, or imaging findings.

Medial Collateral Ligament Injury

A stretch or tear of the strong ligament on the inner side of the knee, often caused by a blow to the outer knee or a twisting injury. It causes inner-knee pain and swelling; severe tears may make the knee unstable.

Medial Cuneiform

The largest of three small bones in the inner middle part of the foot. It joins the navicular bone and the first toe bone, helps support the arch, and forms part of the joint that can be injured in a Lisfranc injury.

Medial Epicondylitis

Alternate medical name; see *Golfer's Elbow*.

Medial Gastrocnemius Strain

Overstretching or tearing of the medial head of the gastrocnemius muscle, often during sudden acceleration or push-off. It causes abrupt calf pain, tenderness, swelling, and pain with walking or ankle movement.

Medial Geniculate Nucleus

A specialized thalamic relay nucleus that receives ascending auditory inputs from the inferior colliculus via the brachium of the inferior colliculus and projects auditory radiations to the primary auditory cortex in the superior temporal gyrus (Brodmann areas 41 and 42).

Alternate Names:
MGN; Medial Geniculate Body

Medial Lemniscus

A prominent ascending sensory white matter tract in the brainstem formed by the decussating internal arcuate fibers from the contralateral gracile and cuneate nuclei of the medulla, conveying conscious proprioception, vibration, and discriminative fine touch to the ventral posterolateral (VPL) nucleus of the thalamus.

Medial Medullary Syndrome

A brainstem stroke syndrome (Dejerine syndrome) caused by infarction of the anteromedial medulla oblongata (typically due to occlusion of the anterior spinal artery or vertebral artery), characterized by ipsilateral hypoglossal nerve (CN XII) palsy (tongue deviates toward lesion), contralateral hemiparesis sparing the face, and contralateral loss of vibration and proprioception.

Alternate Names:
Dejerine Anterior Bulbar Syndrome; Inferior Alternating Hemiplegia

Medial Meniscus

The medial meniscus is a crescent-shaped fibrocartilage pad between the medial femoral condyle and medial tibial plateau. It distributes load and contributes to knee stability; tears may cause joint-line pain, swelling, or locking.

Medial Rotation

Turning a limb toward the body's midline. For example, turning the thigh so the knee and foot point inward is medial rotation; the movement is assessed at joints such as the shoulder and hip.

Medial Tibial Stress Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Shin Splints*.

Median

Located in or relating to the middle plane or midpoint of a structure. In medicine, it describes

anatomy, measurements, statistical values, nerve positions, or locations between two sides.

Median Arcuate Ligament Syndrome

A symptomatic condition involving compression of the celiac artery and nearby nerves by the median arcuate ligament. It may cause post-meal upper-abdominal pain and weight loss, but similar compression is often found in people without symptoms, so imaging alone does not establish the syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Dunbar Syndrome; MALS

Median Nerve

A major nerve running from the neck through the arm and forearm to the hand. It helps bend the wrist and fingers, moves the thumb, and provides feeling to the thumb, index, middle, and part of the ring finger; compression can cause carpal-tunnel symptoms.

Median Nerve Compression

Compression or injury of the median nerve at any point along its course; symptoms depend on the site. Compression at the wrist causes carpal tunnel syndrome.

Median Neuropathy

Dysfunction of the median nerve caused by compression, trauma, inflammation, or another lesion. Numbness, tingling, pain, or weakness may affect the thumb, index, middle, and radial half of the ring finger or related muscles.

Median Plane

A sagittal plane that passes directly through the midline of the body, dividing it into equal right and left halves.

Median Rhomboid Glossitis

A smooth, red, diamond-shaped area without normal surface papillae on the middle back of the tongue. It is often associated with Candida, though the relationship is not always clear, and may cause no symptoms.

Median Survival

The time by which half of the people in a study have experienced the specified event, such as death. It is a summary measure of survival in a defined population.

Mediastinal Cyst

A mediastinal cyst is a fluid- or tissue-filled cystic lesion in the mediastinum. Common types include bronchogenic, thymic, and pericardial cysts; symptoms depend on size and compression, and imaging guides evaluation.

Mediastinal Disease

A disorder affecting structures in the mediastinum, including the heart, great vessels, thymus, lymph nodes, nerves, and tumors or cysts within the central chest.

Mediastinal Emphysema

Mediastinal emphysema, or pneumomediastinum, is the presence of free air in the mediastinum. It can follow alveolar rupture, trauma, surgery, or esophageal injury and may cause chest pain, neck crepitus, or respiratory compromise.

Mediastinal Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the mediastinum, commonly caused by trauma, vascular rupture, surgery, or invasive procedures, and potentially causing airway or cardiovascular compression.

Mediastinal Lymphadenopathy

Enlargement of lymph nodes in the mediastinum. It may occur with infection, inflammation, lymphoma, or cancer that has spread from another organ.

Mediastinal Lymph Nodes

Lymph nodes in the central chest that filter lymph from the lungs, heart, esophagus, and nearby tissues.

Mediastinal Lymphoma

Lymphoma involving lymph nodes or other lymphoid tissue in the mediastinum. It may cause cough, chest pressure, breathlessness, superior vena

cava obstruction, or constitutional symptoms; CT, PET, biopsy, and immunophenotyping establish the type and extent.

Mediastinal Mass

An abnormal growth or collection of tissue in the mediastinum, the central compartment of the chest. Causes include tumors, enlarged lymph nodes, cysts, and vascular abnormalities.

Mediastinal Neoplasm

A mediastinal neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the central space of the chest between the lungs; it may arise from lymph nodes, thymus, nerves, or other tissues.

Mediastinal Pleura

The mediastinal pleura is the portion of parietal pleura lining the lateral surfaces of the mediastinum. It separates the mediastinal contents from the pleural cavity and reflects around the lung root.

Mediastinal Shift

Mediastinal shift is displacement of the mediastinal structures away from their usual position. It may result from increased pressure on one side, such as a tension pneumothorax, or loss of volume on the other, such as lung collapse.

Mediastinal Tumor

A mediastinal tumor is a mass in the central chest compartment between the lungs and may be benign or malignant.

Mediastinitis

Inflammation of tissues in the mediastinum, the central compartment of the chest. Acute cases are usually infections, often following esophageal perforation, deep neck infection spreading downward, or open-heart surgery, and may progress rapidly. Chronic fibrosing mediastinitis is a distinct form in which scar tissue encases mediastinal structures, sometimes after granulomatous infection.

Mediastinoscopes

Mediastinoscopes are slender endoscopic instruments used during mediastinoscopy to inspect the mediastinum and obtain tissue samples, especially from mediastinal lymph nodes. The procedure is performed through a small incision near the sternum.

Mediastinoscopy

A surgical procedure that accesses the mediastinum through a small incision near the sternum to inspect or biopsy mediastinal lymph nodes or masses. It is one option for staging lung cancer when less-invasive sampling is nondiagnostic or unsuitable.

Mediastinoscopy With Biopsy

A procedure using an instrument inserted through a small incision near the sternum to inspect the mediastinum and obtain lymph-node or mass samples for diagnosis and staging.

Mediastinotomy

A surgical opening into the mediastinum to examine or reach structures in the central chest.

Mediastinum

The central part of the chest between the lungs. It contains the heart, major blood vessels, windpipe, food pipe, thymus, nerves, and lymph nodes.

Mediators Of Inflammation

Molecules that start, strengthen, limit, or coordinate inflammation. They include histamine, prostaglandins, cytokines, and other signals that change blood vessels, attract immune cells, cause symptoms, and support healing.

Medical Abbreviations

Alternate name; see *Common Medical Abbreviations And Terms*.

Medical Cannabis And Cannabidiol

Cannabis and cannabidiol are substances from the cannabis plant used in some medical settings. Their effects and risks vary by product and dose; they may

cause sleepiness, impaired judgment, interactions, or dependence, and effectiveness varies by condition.

Medical Condition

A state affecting health or body function, whether temporary, long-lasting, symptomatic, or silent. A medical condition may result from disease, injury, inherited traits, infection, or normal biological changes.

Medical Device

An instrument, implant, machine, software program, or other product used to diagnose, prevent, monitor, or treat disease or injury. Examples include pacemakers, syringes, imaging equipment, and blood-glucose meters.

Medical Entomology

The study of insects and related arthropods that cause disease or transmit disease-causing organisms to humans, including their biology, ecology, physiology, and genetics.

Medical Ethics

Moral principles that guide healthcare decisions, including respect for a person's choices, helping rather than harming, fairness, privacy, and honest communication. Decisions consider the patient's wishes, likely benefits and harms, professional duties, and relevant law.

Medical Examiner

A physician who investigates sudden, unexpected, violent, or suspicious deaths. The examiner may order an autopsy, determine the medical cause of death, and provide information for the official death certificate; exact duties vary by location.

Medical History

A medical history is a structured account of a person's current concerns, past illnesses and operations, medications, allergies, family history, social history, and relevant exposures. It helps guide examination, diagnosis, and treatment.

Medical Illness

The subjective experience of being unwell, which may or may not correspond to an identifiable disease.

Medical Jargon

Specialized words and phrases used by healthcare professionals. Unexplained terms can lead to misunderstanding of a condition, test results, or treatment; plain-language communication improves understanding.

Medical Jurisprudence

The branch of law (and its study) that deals with the rights and duties of physicians and the legal aspects of medical practice, distinct from but overlapping with forensic medicine.

Medical Malpractice

Legal tort occurring when a healthcare provider fails to exercise the standard of reasonable care, skill, or diligence expected of a prudent practitioner of similar standing, resulting in injury, harm, or death to a patient.

Alternate Names:
Clinical Malpractice; Medical Malpractice

Medical Marijuana

Cannabis used under medical supervision to relieve symptoms or support treatment of selected conditions. Products contain cannabinoids such as THC or cannabidiol; effects, interactions, impairment, and dependence risk vary by product and dose.

Medical Nutrition Therapy

Personalized food and nutrition care provided by a qualified dietitian to manage a health problem. It may support people with diabetes, kidney disease, digestive disorders, cancer, obesity, or malnutrition.

Medical Officer

A physician appointed to provide clinical care or medical oversight for an institution, service, or organization.

Medical Physicist

A specialist who applies physics to medical imaging, radiation treatment, and radiation safety. Medical physicists check equipment, calculate radiation doses, and help ensure that scans and cancer treatments are accurate and as safe as possible.

Medical Physics

The application of physics to medicine, including diagnostic imaging, radiation therapy, radiation safety, and physiological measurement.

Medical Pin

A medical pin is a slender metal fixation device inserted into bone or across a joint to stabilize a fracture or support orthopedic treatment. Pins may be temporary or permanent and require monitoring for infection and displacement.

Medical Practitioner

A licensed physician qualified to diagnose, prevent, and treat illness.

Medical Privacy

Protection of information that can identify a patient and control over its sharing. It includes keeping health records secure, limiting access to appropriate people, and obtaining permission when disclosure is not otherwise allowed.

Medical Procedure

An action performed by a health professional to diagnose, monitor, prevent, or treat a health problem. Procedures range from blood tests and scans to surgery and may be done with or without anesthesia.

Alternate Names:
Clinical Procedure; Healthcare Procedure; Medical Intervention

Medical Records

Written or electronic information about a person's health, including symptoms, examinations, test results, diagnoses, medicines, procedures, and follow-up. Accurate records help healthcare professionals coordinate safe care and track changes over time.

Medical Retina

The ophthalmology subspecialty concerned with diagnosis and nonsurgical treatment of retinal and macular diseases. It includes disorders such as diabetic retinopathy, age-related macular degeneration, retinal vascular disease, and inherited retinal conditions; care may involve imaging, medicines, or office-based procedures.

Medical Symbol

A commonly recognized sign representing medicine, especially the Rod of Asclepius: a staff with one serpent. The winged, two-serpent caduceus is often used incorrectly as a medical symbol.

Medical Tattooing

Medical tattooing (permanent makeup, micropigmentation) covers depigmented skin (vitiligo, vitiligo camouflage), restores areolas after mastectomy, and masks scars. Trichopigmentation simulates hair on bald scalp. Medical tattooing uses specialized pigments and techniques.

Medical Tests

Diagnostic procedures used to screen for, confirm, or monitor disease through analysis of biologic specimens, imaging, physiologic measurements, or genetic material.

Medicinal

Relating to a substance or treatment used for the prevention, diagnosis, relief, or treatment of disease.

Medicine

A substance or treatment used to prevent, diagnose, relieve, or treat disease. Medicines may be prescription, over-the-counter, biological, or traditional, and all can have benefits, risks, and interactions.

Medicines For Back Pain

Medicines for back pain may include selected anti-inflammatory drugs, acetaminophen, muscle relaxants, or other treatments depending on the cause

and patient risks.

Medicines For Osteoporosis

Osteoporosis medicines reduce bone loss or increase bone formation and may include bisphosphonates, denosumab, or anabolic treatments chosen according to fracture risk.

Medicines For Sleep

Medicines for sleep may help short-term insomnia but can cause dependence, falls, confusion, or next-day impairment; treatment approaches also vary with the cause of poor sleep.

Medicolegal

Pertaining to the application of medical knowledge to legal questions and the intersection of medicine and the law. Covers forensic pathology, toxicology, psychiatry, and clinical issues: informed consent, malpractice, medical records, disability, personal injury, occupational disease, and public health law.

Meditation

Meditation is a practice of intentionally directing attention, often toward the breath, a sensation, or an object, while observing thoughts without judgment. It may promote relaxation and stress management but does not replace indicated medical treatment.

Mediterranean Anemia

Alternate name; see *Thalassemia*.

Mediterranean Diet

An eating pattern rich in vegetables, fruits, beans, whole grains, nuts, olive oil, and fish, with less red and processed meat and added sugar. It can support cardiovascular health as part of an overall balanced diet.

Mediterranean Fever

An older name for brucellosis, a bacterial infection that can cause prolonged fever, sweats, fatigue, and joint or muscle pain.

Medium

A substance or condition through which something occurs; in microbiology, a culture medium supports the growth of microorganisms.

MEDLARS

Medical Literature Analysis and Retrieval System, an electronic bibliographic system developed by the U.S. National Library of Medicine to index and retrieve biomedical literature; it preceded MEDLINE.

Medroxyprogesterone

Medroxyprogesterone is a progestogen used for contraception, abnormal uterine bleeding, endometriosis, and hormone therapy; depot injections may cause irregular bleeding, weight change, delayed fertility return, and reduced bone density.

Medroxyprogesterone Acetate

Medroxyprogesterone acetate is a synthetic progestin used in hormonal contraception, treatment of endometriosis or abnormal uterine bleeding, and hormone therapy. It suppresses ovulation and produces progestational effects; formulation-specific risks and contraindications apply.

Medulla

The inner or central part of an organ, such as the renal medulla or adrenal medulla.

Medulla Oblongata

The lower part of the brainstem, joined to the spinal cord. It helps control breathing, heart rate, blood pressure, swallowing, coughing, vomiting, and other automatic functions.

Medullary

Relating to the medulla or inner portion of an organ.

Medullary Carcinoma

A term used for distinct cancers in different organs. Medullary carcinoma of the thyroid arises from calcitonin-producing C cells; medullary-pattern breast carcinoma has a different origin and appearance. The organ must be specified because the

diagnoses are not the same.

Medullary Cavity

The hollow space inside the shaft of a long bone. It contains bone marrow and blood vessels.

Medullary Sponge Kidney

A condition present from birth in which tiny urine-collecting tubes inside the kidneys are widened. Urine minerals may form stones or deposits, causing blood in the urine, repeated infections, pain, or no symptoms.

Medullary Thyroid Carcinoma

A cancer of hormone-producing thyroid cells that make calcitonin. It may occur alone or as part of an inherited syndrome; blood tests, imaging, and a biopsy help confirm it.

Medulloblastoma

A fast-growing cancer that usually starts in the cerebellum, the part of the brain that helps with balance and coordination. It occurs most often in children but can also affect adults. It may spread through the fluid around the brain and spinal cord and can cause headaches, vomiting, or unsteady walking.

Medulloepithelioma

A medulloepithelioma is a rare embryonal tumor arising most often from the nonpigmented ciliary epithelium of the eye in children. It may cause visual symptoms, neovascular glaucoma, or a visible mass and is treated according to its extent and pathology.

Mees' Lines

True leukonychia characterized by single or multiple paired, non-blanching transverse white bands across the nail plate that migrate distally as the nail grows. Classically associated with acute arsenic or thallium poisoning, Hodgkin lymphoma, and severe systemic illness.

Alternate Names:
Aldrich-Mees Lines; Mees Lines

Mefenamic Acid

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for short-term pain, including menstrual pain. It can irritate or bleed from the stomach, affect kidney function, and increase cardiovascular risk, especially with prolonged use or in people with risk factors.

Mefloquine

Mefloquine is an antimalarial drug used for prevention and treatment of susceptible malaria. It has a long half-life and can cause neuropsychiatric, vestibular, and cardiac adverse effects; risks vary with medical history and concurrent medicines.

Megabecquerel

A megabecquerel (MBq) is a unit of radioactivity equal to one million nuclear disintegrations per second. It is used to state the activity of radiopharmaceuticals and other radioactive materials.

Megacalycosis

Congenital, nonobstructive dilatation of the renal calyces, usually with otherwise preserved renal architecture and function. It is often incidental and can resemble obstructive hydronephrosis on imaging.

Megacolon

Abnormal enlargement and dilation of the colon, which may be congenital, acquired, toxic, or inflammatory.

Megakaryocyte

A very large cell in the bone marrow that makes platelets, the small blood parts that help stop bleeding. It grows long extensions into nearby blood vessels, where pieces break off and enter the bloodstream as platelets.

Megakaryocytopoiesis

Megakaryocytopoiesis is the formation and maturation of megakaryocytes in the bone marrow, followed by platelet production. It is regulated in large part by thrombopoietin and other hematopoietic signals.

Megaloblast

An unusually large, immature cell in bone marrow that normally matures into a red blood cell. It usually reflects faulty DNA production, commonly caused by vitamin B12 or folate deficiency.

Megaloblastic Anaemia

A macrocytic anemia caused by impaired DNA synthesis, most often from vitamin B12 or folate deficiency. Bone marrow produces abnormally large, immature red-cell precursors, and other blood-cell counts may also fall. Vitamin B12 deficiency can cause neurologic injury, sometimes before anemia develops; prolonged injury may be permanent.

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Megalocephaly

Alternate name; see *Macrocephaly*.

Megamonas Funiformis

Megamonas funiformis is an anaerobic bacterium of the genus Megamonas, commonly associated with the intestinal microbiota. Its detection in a clinical specimen requires interpretation alongside symptoms, specimen quality, and other microbiologic findings.

Megamonas Hypermegale

Megamonas hypermegale is an anaerobic bacterium in the genus Megamonas, primarily associated with the gastrointestinal microbiota. Its presence in a specimen is interpreted in relation to the site, clinical symptoms, and other microbiologic results.

Megasphaera

Megasphaera is a genus of anaerobic bacteria found in the oral cavity and gastrointestinal and genital microbiota. Species identification may be relevant in microbiome studies or when recovered from a clinical specimen.

Megaureter

An abnormally widened ureter, the tube that carries urine from the kidney to the bladder. It may result from a blockage, urine flowing backward, or abnormal ureter development and can cause infection, kidney swelling, or reduced kidney function.

Megestrol

Megestrol is a synthetic progestin used in some settings to treat hormone-responsive cancers and, in certain formulations, anorexia or severe weight loss. It can cause glucocorticoid-like effects, thromboembolic risk, and adrenal suppression.

Megestrol Acetate

Megestrol acetate is the acetate salt of the progestin megestrol. Depending on formulation and indication, it is used for advanced endometrial or breast cancer and for appetite stimulation in selected patients with severe weight loss.

Meglitinides

Short-acting diabetes medicines that encourage the pancreas to release insulin around mealtimes. They lower blood sugar but can cause low blood sugar and weight gain, so doses are usually linked to meals and skipped when a meal is skipped.

Megrim

Older term; see *Migraine*.

Meibomian Gland Dysfunction

A long-term problem with the oil-producing glands in the eyelids. Blocked ducts or abnormal oil can make tears evaporate too quickly, causing dry, irritated eyes.

Alternate Names:
MGD

Meibomian Glands

Sebaceous glands in the eyelids that produce the oily layer of the tear film and help prevent tear

evaporation.

Meibomianitis

Meibomianitis is inflammation or blockage of oil-producing eyelid glands, causing irritated eyelid margins, dry eye, crusting, or recurrent styes.

Meige Syndrome

A movement disorder causing repeated involuntary eyelid squeezing and muscle spasms around the mouth, jaw, or tongue. Symptoms may worsen with stress, speaking, chewing, or touch.

Meigs Syndrome

A rare condition involving an ovarian fibroma, fluid in the abdomen, and fluid around the lungs. The fluid usually clears after the tumor is removed.

Meigs' Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Meigs Syndrome*.

Meiosis

A specialized cell division that produces haploid eggs or sperm from a diploid precursor cell and creates genetic variation through recombination and chromosome assortment.

Meiotic Recombination

Meiotic recombination is exchange of DNA between homologous chromosomes during meiosis, usually through crossing over. It creates new combinations of alleles and contributes to genetic variation.

Meissner Corpuscle

An encapsulated, rapidly adapting mechanoreceptor located in the dermal papillae of glabrous (hairless) skin (fingertips, palms, soles, lips), sensitive to low-frequency vibrations (30 to 50 Hz), light touch, and dynamic skin flutter.

Alternate Names:
Tactile Corpuscle

Meissner Plexus

A network of unmyelinated autonomic nerve fibers and parasympathetic postganglionic neuronal cell bodies located within the submucosa of the gastrointestinal tract, primarily regulating local glandular secretions, mucosal absorption, and submucosal blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Submucosal Plexus

Meissner's Corpuscles

Small touch sensors in hairless skin, especially the fingertips, palms, and soles. They help the nervous system detect gentle contact, texture, and movement across the skin.

MEK Inhibitor

A targeted medicine that blocks MEK proteins in the MAPK signaling pathway, which can slow growth of some cancers with pathway changes. Side effects vary and may include rash, diarrhea, heart effects, and eye problems.

Melancholia

An older term for severe depression, often describing pervasive sadness, loss of pleasure, psychomotor change, and biological symptoms.

Melancholic Features

A pattern of severe depression marked by almost complete loss of pleasure, very low mood, major changes in movement or sleep, poor appetite or weight loss, excessive guilt, and symptoms that are often worse in the morning.

Melanin

Melanin is a pigment produced by melanocytes that gives skin, hair, and eyes their colour and absorbs ultraviolet radiation; its amount and distribution influence pigmentation disorders and melanoma biology.

Melanoblast

A precursor cell that develops into a melanocyte and produces pigment after migrating into the skin and other tissues.

Melanocyte

A specialized, dendritic, melanin-synthesizing cell originating embryologically from the neural crest that migrates during development into the stratum basale of the epidermis, hair follicles, uveal tract of the eye (iris, ciliary body, choroid), inner ear stria vascularis, and leptomeninges. Within the epidermis, melanocytes reside at a regular density of approximately 1 melanocyte per 10 basal keratinocytes, associating with 30 to 40 surrounding keratinocytes to form the 'epidermal melanin unit.' Melanocytes express tyrosinase, a copper-containing enzyme that catalyzes the rate-limiting oxidation of L-tyrosine to DOPA and dopaquinone within specialized lysosome-related organelles called melanosomes. Melanosomes synthesize photoprotective brown-black eumelanin or reddish-yellow pheomelanin, which are transferred via dendritic processes into neighboring keratinocytes to form a supranuclear melanin cap that shields nuclear DNA from ultraviolet (UV) radiation-induced pyrimidine dimer mutations. Melanocyte proliferation, survival, and melanogenesis are regulated by microphthalmia-associated transcription factor (MITF), α-melanocyte-stimulating hormone (α-MSH) binding to melanocortin 1 receptors (MC1R), and stem cell factor (SCF) binding to KIT. Neoplastic transformation of melanocytes gives rise to melanoma.

Melanocytes

Plural form; see *Melanocyte*.

Melanocytic CNS Tumor

A tumor showing melanocytic differentiation within the CNS or meninges, ranging from benign melanocytoma to malignant melanoma. Evaluation includes imaging, histology, and molecular assessment to determine behavior.

Melanocytic Nevi

Common moles formed by collections of pigment-producing melanocytes. Most are harmless, but changes in size, shape, color, or symptoms can be associated with melanoma.

Melanocytic Nevus

A usually benign, localized proliferation of melanocytes that appears as a macule, papule, or nodule. Changes in size, color, border, or symptoms can indicate atypia or melanoma.

Melanoderma

Increased pigmentation or darkening of the skin caused by increased melanin production or an increased number of melanocytes.

Melanoma

A serious and aggressive type of skin cancer that develops in melanocytes, the cells responsible for producing melanin, the pigment that gives skin its color. While it accounts for a small percentage of skin cancers, it is responsible for the majority of skin cancer deaths because of its tendency to spread rapidly to lymph nodes and other organs. Most melanomas are triggered by ultraviolet (UV) radiation from sunlight or tanning equipment, often appearing as an unusual, irregularly shaped, or changing mole.

Alternate Names:
Malignant Melanoma; Cutaneous Melanoma

Melanoma Of The Eye

A cancer arising from pigment-producing cells in the eye, most often the uveal tract. It may cause blurred vision, flashes, a growing dark spot, or no symptoms at first; diagnosis is made by specialist eye examination and imaging.

Melanoma Skin Cancer

Alternate name; see *Melanoma*.

Melanoma/Skin Cancer

Alternate name; see *Melanoma*.

Melanoma Surveillance

Ongoing examination of the skin and, when appropriate, the eyes or other previously affected sites after melanoma or in people at increased risk. It may include self-checks, clinician examination, dermoscopy, photographs, and evaluation of new or

changing lesions.

Melanoma Treatment

Treatment depends on the tumor's depth, spread, molecular findings, overall health, and previous treatment. Localized melanoma is usually removed surgically; selected cases need lymph-node assessment or additional medicine. Disease that has spread may require immune-based or targeted treatment, surgery, radiation, or combinations.

Melanonychia

Brown, gray, or black pigmentation of a nail plate caused by increased melanin or pigment-producing cells. It may affect several nails from medicines or systemic disease; a new or changing single-nail band can indicate nail-unit melanoma.

Melanophore

A melanophore is a pigment-containing cell, especially one in lower vertebrates, whose melanin granules can disperse or aggregate to alter visible coloration. In mammals, melanocytes are the principal melanin-producing cells.

Melanosis

Abnormal accumulation or increased production of melanin in skin, mucosa, an organ, or other tissue.

Melanosis Coli

Dark pigmentation of the colon lining caused by lipofuscin accumulation, classically associated with prolonged stimulant-laxative use. It is usually benign and may fade after the trigger is removed; associated constipation or laxative use may persist.

Melanosome

A melanosome is a specialized organelle in a melanocyte in which melanin is synthesized, stored, and transported. Melanosomes are transferred to keratinocytes and influence skin, hair, and eye pigmentation.

Melasma

An acquired pigmentary disorder causing symmetric light- to dark-brown or gray-brown patches, usually on sun-exposed areas of the face. It is associated with ultraviolet and visible light exposure and hormonal factors, including pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Facial Melanosis

MELAS Syndrome

A mitochondrial disorder involving encephalopathy, lactic acidosis, and stroke-like episodes, often beginning before adulthood and caused by pathogenic mitochondrial DNA variants.

Melatonin

A hormone produced mainly by the pineal gland that helps coordinate sleep and wake timing. Darkness usually increases its release, while light suppresses it; supplements can cause drowsiness and medicine interactions.

Melatonin Receptor

A cell-surface receptor activated by the hormone melatonin. The main types, MT1 and MT2, help regulate the body's sleep-wake clock and seasonal rhythms and are targets of some sleep medicines.

Melatonin Receptor Agonists

Medicines that act like melatonin at receptors involved in the body's sleep-wake clock. They may help some people fall asleep, but choice of treatment depends on the cause of insomnia, other medicines, and health conditions.

MELD

Model for End-Stage Liver Disease, a laboratory-based score used to estimate severity of advanced liver disease and help prioritize adults for liver transplantation. Traditional versions use bilirubin, creatinine, and INR; current implementations may include additional variables.

MELD-Na Score

A version of the Model for End-Stage Liver Disease that includes serum sodium along with bilirubin, creatinine, and INR to estimate short-term mortality in advanced liver disease. Transplant allocation

systems and score formulas vary by country and may change over time.

Alternate Names:
MELD-Sodium Score; Sodium-Adjusted MELD

MELD Score

A medical score estimating the severity and short-term risk of death from advanced liver disease. It uses laboratory results and helps guide urgency for liver transplantation; the calculation may vary as official versions are updated.

Melena

Black, sticky, often foul-smelling stool caused by digested blood, usually from bleeding in the stomach or upper intestine. It can signal serious gastrointestinal bleeding.

Melibiose

A disaccharide composed of galactose and glucose, produced by hydrolysis of raffinose and metabolized by some microorganisms.

Melio

An older shortened form related to melioidosis, the infection caused by Burkholderia pseudomallei.

Melioidosis

An infectious disease caused by Burkholderia pseudomallei, usually acquired from contaminated soil or water through inoculation or inhalation. It may cause pneumonia, skin infection, abscesses, sepsis, or chronic disease and is more severe in people with diabetes or other risk factors.

Melitensis

A species designation, especially Brucella melitensis, a bacterium that causes brucellosis and is associated with goats and sheep.

Melitten

Melitten, more commonly spelled melittin, is the principal peptide toxin in honeybee venom. It disrupts cell membranes and contributes to pain, inflammation, hemolysis, and other effects of envenomation.

Melkersson-Rosenthal Syndrome

A rare neuromucocutaneous disorder characterized by the classic clinical triad of recurrent orofacial edema (especially granulomatous cheilitis of the lips), relapsing peripheral facial nerve (CN VII) palsy, and a fissured tongue (lingua plicata).

Alternate Names:
Cheilitis Granulomatosa Triad; Fissured Tongue and Facial Palsy Syndrome

Melorheostosis

A rare sclerosing bone dysplasia producing irregular, flowing cortical hyperostosis on imaging. It may cause pain, stiffness, limb deformity, restricted movement, contractures, or soft-tissue fibrosis and can affect one or several contiguous bones.

Meloxicam

Meloxicam is a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug that inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes and reduces prostaglandin synthesis. It is used for pain and inflammation, but can cause gastrointestinal, renal, cardiovascular, and hypersensitivity adverse effects.

Melphalan

A chemotherapy medicine that damages cancer cells by interfering with their DNA. It is used for selected blood cancers and other cancers, but can also suppress bone marrow and increase infection or bleeding risk.

Memantine

An NMDA receptor antagonist (uncompetitive, low-to-moderate affinity) used for moderate to severe Alzheimer disease, often added to an acetylcholinesterase inhibitor. Blocks excessive glutamate-mediated excitotoxicity while preserving normal synaptic transmission. Once or twice daily oral.

Memantine Hydrochloride

Memantine hydrochloride is an NMDA-receptor antagonist used to help manage moderate-to-severe Alzheimer disease. It reduces pathologic glutamate-mediated excitotoxicity; common adverse effects

include dizziness, headache, constipation, and confusion.

Membrane

A thin sheet of tissue or material that surrounds a cell, organ, or body cavity. Membranes can protect structures, separate spaces, allow selected substances to pass, and produce or absorb fluids.

Membrane Channel

A membrane channel is a protein-forming pore across a cell membrane that permits selected ions or molecules to pass down an electrochemical or concentration gradient. Many channels are gated by voltage, ligands, or mechanical forces.

Membrane Fusion

Membrane fusion is merging of two lipid bilayers into one continuous membrane. It is required for processes such as synaptic vesicle release, enveloped-virus entry, fertilization, and intracellular vesicle trafficking.

Membrane Lipids

Fat-like molecules that form the main structure of cell membranes. They create a flexible barrier, help cells communicate, and provide attachment sites for proteins; abnormal lipid composition can affect signaling and cell function.

Membrane Microdomain

A membrane microdomain is a small, specialized region of a cell membrane with a distinct composition of lipids and proteins. It can organize receptors, signaling molecules, transporters, and cytoskeletal interactions.

Membrane Part

A membrane part is a structural or molecular component of a biological membrane, such as a lipid, protein, carbohydrate, channel, or receptor. These components determine membrane integrity, transport, signaling, and cell recognition.

Membrane Potential

The electrical potential difference across a cell membrane, approximately -70 mV in most neurons (resting membrane potential). Established by the unequal distribution of ions (primarily K+, Na+, Cl-) across the membrane and selective permeability.

Membrane Protein

A protein attached to or embedded in a cell membrane. It may transport substances, receive signals, act as an enzyme, join cells, anchor the cytoskeleton, or help the immune system identify cells.

Membrane Raft

A membrane raft is a cholesterol- and sphingolipid-enriched membrane microdomain that helps cluster selected proteins and signaling molecules. Raft organization is dynamic and may change during receptor signaling or membrane trafficking.

Membranoproliferative Glomerulonephritis

A pattern of kidney-filter damage that can cause blood and protein in the urine, swelling, and reduced kidney function. Causes include immune disorders, infections, and some blood cancers.

Membranous

Relating to, consisting of, or resembling a membrane. In medicine, the term may describe a thin tissue layer or a disease pattern involving such a layer.

Membranous Labyrinth

A continuous system of communicating, endolymph-filled epithelial sacs and ducts lodged within the bony labyrinth of the inner ear, comprising the cochlear duct (hearing) and the vestibular apparatus (utricle, saccule, and three semicircular ducts for balance and equilibrium).

Membranous Nephropathy

A kidney disease in which the filtering units are injured by immune proteins deposited along their delicate filter. It often causes large amounts of protein in the urine and swelling and may be linked to autoimmune disease, infection, medicines, or cancer.

Memory

The ability to learn, store, and recall information. Memory depends on several connected areas of the brain and can be affected by sleep problems, stress, medicines, injury, illness, aging, or brain disorders.

Memory Cell

A long-lasting B cell or T cell formed after an infection or vaccination. If the same germ is encountered again, memory cells respond faster and more strongly, helping prevent illness or reduce its severity.

Memory Disorder

Impairment of encoding, storage, retrieval, or recognition of information that exceeds normal variation and may result from neurodegeneration, injury, vascular disease, medication, or other causes.

Memory Impairment

Memory impairment is reduced ability to learn, store, retrieve, or recognize information. It may be transient or persistent and can result from normal aging, medications, sleep problems, neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, or other medical conditions.

Memory Loss

Reduced ability to recall past information, form new memories, or both. Causes include normal aging, medicines, head injury, seizures, stroke, infection, substance use, neurocognitive disorders, and psychological conditions; sudden memory loss can occur with serious illness.

Memory Span

The number of items, such as words or digits, that a person can briefly retain and recall, usually in the original order; it is a measure of short-term or working memory.

Memory T Cells And B Cells

Long-lived immune cells that remember earlier exposures and respond faster when they meet the same target again. They support lasting protection after infection or vaccination, though protection may fade.

Alternate Names:
Memory Lymphocytes

MEN 2

Abbreviation; see *Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2*.

Menarche

The first menstrual period, usually occurring about 2–3 years after breast development. Its timing varies with genetics, nutrition, health, and pubertal progression. Absence of menstruation by age 15 or more than 3 years after breast development began is termed delayed menarche.

Mendelian Inheritance

Inheritance of traits determined by single genes and transmitted according to dominant, recessive, or sex-linked patterns.

Mendelism

The principles of inheritance based on Gregor Mendel's work, including segregation of alleles and independent assortment of genes; Mendelian traits may follow autosomal or X-linked dominant or recessive patterns.

Mendelson Syndrome

A chemical pneumonitis caused by inhalation of acidic stomach contents, classically during anesthesia or childbirth. It can cause cough, breathing difficulty, and impaired oxygenation.

Menetrier Disease

A rare disorder of the stomach lining, usually affecting the body and fundus (upper part) of the stomach, in which mucus-producing cells overgrow and form unusually large folds. The lining can leak protein into the stomach, lowering blood albumin and sometimes causing swelling; stomach acid is also reduced. Adult disease is often chronic and is associated with an increased risk of stomach cancer, while childhood cases are often temporary.

Alternate Names:

Hypertrophic Protein-Losing Gastropathy; Giant Hypertrophic Gastritis; Ménétrier Disease; Ménétrier's Disease; Ménétrier's Disease

Meniere Disease

An inner-ear disorder that causes repeated attacks of spinning dizziness, often with hearing loss that comes and goes, ringing, and a feeling of fullness in one ear. Attacks can last from 20 minutes to 12 hours.

Alternate Names:
Ménière's Disease; Meniere's Disease; Ménière Disease; Meniere's Syndrome

Meningeal Carcinomatosis

Spread of cancer cells to the thin coverings and fluid around the brain and spinal cord. It may cause headache, nausea, weakness, seizures, vision changes, or problems with movement and is managed according to the primary cancer and extent of spread.

Meningeal Leukemia

Meningeal leukemia is leukemia involving the membranes or fluid around the brain and spinal cord, potentially causing headache, weakness, or cranial-nerve problems.

Meningeal Lymphoma

Meningeal lymphoma is lymphoma affecting the membranes or fluid spaces around the brain and spinal cord.

Meningeal Neoplasm

A meningeal neoplasm is an abnormal growth arising in or near the membranes surrounding the brain and spinal cord.

Meninges

Three protective layers surrounding the brain and spinal cord. Cerebrospinal fluid circulates in the space between the arachnoid and pia mater, cushioning the nervous system; bleeding or infection involving the meninges can be dangerous.

Meningioma

A growth in the thin layers of tissue that cover the brain and spinal cord. Many grow slowly and are noncancerous, but some grow faster or are cancerous. Symptoms depend on whether the growth presses on the brain, spinal cord, or nearby nerves.

Meningioma Pathology

A usually extra-axial tumor showing meningothelial cells in syncytial sheets, whorls, or other patterns, sometimes with psammoma bodies. Histologic grade reflects mitotic activity, invasion, and other atypical or anaplastic features.

Meningism

A syndrome of neck stiffness, headache, and sometimes photophobia or vomiting that resembles meningeal irritation without necessarily indicating meningitis. Causes include serious conditions such as infection or subarachnoid hemorrhage.

Meningismus

Neck stiffness and other signs of irritation around the brain and spinal cord without proven inflammation of those coverings. It can occur with fever, severe headache, dehydration, bleeding, or other illnesses.

Meningitis

Inflammation of the meninges, the protective membranes that surround and cushion the brain and spinal cord. It is most commonly caused by viral or bacterial infections, though fungi, parasites, and non-infectious conditions can also cause it. Characteristic symptoms include a sudden high fever, severe headache, stiff neck, and sensitivity to light. Bacterial meningitis progresses rapidly and is a medical emergency that can lead to permanent hearing loss, brain damage, or death.

Meningocele

Protrusion of the meninges through a defect in the skull or vertebral column, usually forming a sac containing cerebrospinal fluid. In a spinal meningocele, a form of spina bifida, the meninges bulge through an opening in the vertebrae while the spinal cord

remains in the spinal canal. The sac may or may not be covered by skin. Neurologic effects vary with associated spinal or nerve abnormalities and are generally less severe than in myelomeningocele.

Meningocele Repair

Surgery to close an opening in the spine and return the protective coverings of the spinal cord to their proper position. It aims to prevent injury or infection; nerve, bladder, bowel, movement, or fluid problems may remain or develop.

Meningococcal Disease

A serious infection caused by Neisseria meningitidis that can produce meningitis or rapidly spreading bloodstream infection. Fever, severe headache, stiff neck, confusion, vomiting, or a purple rash may occur.

Meningococcal Infection

An infection caused by the bacterium Neisseria meningitidis. It may remain mild or cause life-threatening meningitis or bloodstream infection, with fever, headache, stiff neck, vomiting, confusion, or a purple rash developing quickly.

Meningococcal Meningitis

Acute bacterial meningitis caused by *Neisseria meningitidis*. It typically causes fever, headache, and neck stiffness and may occur with meningococcemia, a bloodstream infection that can cause sepsis and a petechial or purpuric rash.

Meningococcemia

Meningococcemia is bloodstream infection with Neisseria meningitidis, causing fever, rash, shock, clotting failure, and potentially fatal sepsis.

Meningococcus

Neisseria meningitidis, a bacterium that can cause meningitis or rapidly spreading bloodstream infection. It spreads through respiratory secretions and may cause fever, headache, rash, shock, or death.

Meningoencephalitis

Inflammation of both the meninges surrounding the brain and the brain tissue itself, usually caused by infection or autoimmune disease. Fever, headache, neck stiffness, confusion, seizures, or reduced consciousness may occur; severe cases can be life-threatening.

Meningomyelocele

A birth defect in which the protective coverings and spinal-cord tissue bulge through an opening in the spine. It can cause weakness or paralysis of the legs and bladder or bowel problems.

Meniscal Allograft Transplantation

Surgery placing a donated meniscus into a knee after substantial loss of the person's own meniscus. It may reduce pain in carefully selected younger patients, but healing is variable and infection, stiffness, graft failure, or later arthritis can occur.

Meniscal Injuries

Tears or other damage to the knee menisci, which are crescent-shaped pieces of cartilage that help distribute load and stabilize the knee. Symptoms may include joint-line pain, swelling, clicking, or restricted motion. Diagnosis is based on examination and, when needed, imaging.

Alternate Names:
Meniscal Injury

Meniscal Tear

A split in one of the two rubbery cartilage pads that cushion the knee. It may follow a twisting injury or gradual wear and can cause pain along the joint line, swelling, clicking, catching, locking, or a feeling that the knee gives way.

Meniscectomy

An operation that removes part or all of a damaged meniscus, the rubbery pad that cushions the knee. Surgeons usually remove only the torn portion when possible, because preserving meniscus helps protect the joint from later wear.

Meniscus

A crescent-shaped fibrocartilage structure in the knee, or a curved fluid surface in a container.

Meniscus Tear

Alternate name; see *Torn Meniscus*.

Menkes Disease

A rare inherited disorder, usually caused by changes in the *ATP7A* gene, that disrupts the movement of copper through the body. Copper levels become low in the brain and other tissues, affecting the nervous system and growth. Symptoms usually begin in infancy and may include developmental delay or loss of skills, weak muscle tone, seizures, poor growth, and sparse, brittle, or tightly curled hair.

Menkes Kinky Hair Syndrome

An X-linked disorder of copper transport caused by ATP7A dysfunction. It produces progressive neurodegeneration, seizures, developmental delay, hypopigmented or brittle kinky hair, connective-tissue abnormalities, and failure to thrive.

Menogaril

Menogaril is a semisynthetic anthracycline derivative of nogalamycin. It intercalates into DNA and inhibits topoisomerase II, thereby impairing DNA replication and repair; it was investigated as an antineoplastic agent.

Menometrorrhagia

Excessive uterine bleeding occurring both at expected menstrual times and at irregular intervals; the older term corresponds broadly to heavy and irregular menstrual bleeding, which can have an underlying cause.

Menopausal

Relating to menopause or the years around the permanent end of menstrual periods. Hormone changes may cause hot flashes, sleep problems, mood changes, vaginal dryness, and increased bone-loss risk.

Menopausal Hormone Therapy

Treatment with estrogen, with progestogen when needed to protect the uterus, for troublesome hot flashes, night sweats, or vaginal symptoms during menopause. It may affect clot, stroke, breast-cancer, and other risks, so treatment is individualized.

Menopausal Hot Flashes

Alternate name; see *Hot Flashes*.

Menopause

The permanent end of menstrual periods because of loss of ovarian activity, usually diagnosed after 12 consecutive months without menstruation. Hormonal changes may cause hot flashes, night sweats, vaginal symptoms, sleep problems, or other symptoms.

Menopause and Mood Disorders

Mood symptoms can occur during the menopausal transition because of hormonal fluctuation, sleep disruption, vasomotor symptoms, life stress, or an independent depressive or anxiety disorder. Persistent, severe, or suicidal symptoms can indicate a significant mental-health condition; treatment is individualized.

Menopause And Perimenopause

Perimenopause is the transition before menopause, when menstrual periods and hormone levels become irregular. Menopause is reached after 12 consecutive months without a period when no other cause explains it.

Menopause Status

Menopause status describes whether a person is premenopausal, perimenopausal, or postmenopausal. Natural menopause is clinically defined after 12 consecutive months without menstruation when no other cause explains the amenorrhea.

Menopause Syndrome

A nontechnical term for the group of symptoms that may occur during the menopausal transition, such as hot flashes, night sweats, sleep problems, mood changes, vaginal dryness, and menstrual irregularity.

Menopause itself is a normal life stage, not a disease.

Menorrhagia

Older term; see *Heavy Menstrual Bleeding*.

Menorrhagia (Heavy Menstrual Bleeding)

Alternate name; see *Heavy Menstrual Bleeding*.

Menotropin

Menotropin is a urinary-derived preparation containing follicle-stimulating and luteinizing hormone activity, used to stimulate follicular development or spermatogenesis; ovarian hyperstimulation and multiple pregnancy are important risks.

Menses Duration

The number of days of menstrual bleeding in a cycle, counted from the first day of bleeding until bleeding stops. Persistently prolonged, heavy, or irregular bleeding can reflect an underlying condition.

Menstrual

Relating to menstruation or the menstrual cycle, including the monthly shedding of the uterine lining and the bleeding that follows. Cycle length and bleeding vary; very heavy, painful, irregular, or unexpected bleeding can have an underlying cause.

Menstrual Cramps

Cramping pain in the lower abdomen during or around menstruation, medically called dysmenorrhea. Pain may radiate to the back or thighs and may occur with nausea, diarrhea, headache, or fatigue. Severe, worsening, or newly developed pain requires evaluation for causes such as endometriosis or fibroids.

Alternate Names:
Dysmenorrhea; Period Pain; Painful Menstruation

Menstrual Cycle

The recurring hormonal and uterine changes that prepare the body for possible pregnancy. Cycle length and bleeding pattern vary among individuals and across life stages.

Menstrual Disorders

Conditions involving abnormal menstrual timing, regularity, duration, amount of bleeding, or pain. They include absent or infrequent periods, irregular cycles, unusually heavy or prolonged bleeding, painful periods, and bleeding between periods or after sex. Causes include pregnancy, hormonal or ovulatory disorders, fibroids, endometriosis, thyroid disease, medicines, structural abnormalities, and perimenopause; persistent, heavy, or unexpected bleeding can reflect an underlying disorder.

Menstruation

The periodic shedding of the endometrial lining as part of the menstrual cycle when pregnancy does not occur. The timing, duration, and amount of bleeding vary with age, hormonal state, medicines, and health conditions.

Alternate Names:
Menorrhea

Menstruation Disturbance

Alternate name; see *Menstrual Disorders*.

Mental

Relating to thinking, memory, emotion, behavior, or other functions of the mind. It does not by itself mean that a condition is psychiatric.

Mental Age

An estimate of cognitive functioning expressed as the age level at which a standardized test score is typical; it is not the same as chronological age.

Mental Disorder

A clinically significant syndrome or psychological and behavioral pattern characterized by a prominent disturbance in an individual's cognition, emotional regulation, or behavior that reflects a dysfunction in the psychological, biological, or developmental processes underlying mental and behavioral functioning. Diagnostic classification systems (such as the DSM-5-TR and ICD-11) require that the symptoms cause clinically significant subjective distress or impairment in personal, social, occupational, educational, or other important areas of functioning, and are

not an expectable or culturally sanctioned response to a common stressor or loss (such as normal bereavement). Major categories include neurodevelopmental disorders, schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders, bipolar and related disorders, depressive disorders, anxiety disorders, obsessive-compulsive disorders, trauma- and stressor-related disorders, personality disorders, and substance use disorders. Etiology is multifactorial, best conceptualized through the biopsychosocial model integrating genetic vulnerability, neurochemical dysregulation, structural brain circuitry alterations, environmental adverse experiences, and psychological factors.

Mental Disorders

Plural form; see *Mental Disorder*.

Mental Disorders In Children

Mental disorders in children involve persistent, developmentally atypical disturbances in mood, thinking, behavior, or functioning that cause clinically significant distress or impairment. Symptoms must be interpreted in relation to the child's developmental stage and distinguished from normal variation, temporary reactions, and age-appropriate behavior.

Mental Fatigue

Mental fatigue is a subjective feeling of reduced mental energy, concentration, or cognitive endurance after sustained effort or illness. Persistent or severe symptoms may accompany sleep disorders, depression, neurologic disease, medication effects, or other medical conditions.

Mental Health

Mental health encompasses emotional, psychological, and social well-being, affecting how individuals think, feel, behave, and handle stress, relationships, and decision-making.

Mental Health Crisis

A period of severe emotional, behavioral, or psychological distress in which a person's usual ability to cope or maintain safety is overwhelmed. It may involve suicidal thoughts, severe agitation, psychosis, substance intoxication, or inability to care for basic needs; it may or may not meet criteria for a psychiatric emergency.

Mental Illness

A broad, commonly used term for mental disorders and related conditions affecting mood, thinking, behavior, perception, or daily functioning. See *Mental Disorder*.

Mental Illness In Children

Broad, commonly used term; see *Mental Disorders In Children*.

Mental Process

A mental process is a cognitive or affective activity of the mind, such as perception, attention, memory, reasoning, language, emotion, or decision-making.

Mental Recall

Mental recall is retrieval of previously learned or stored information from memory. It may be assessed by asking a person to remember facts, events, words, or experiences after a delay.

Mental Status Examination

A structured part of a clinical interview that assesses a person's appearance, behavior, speech, mood, thinking, perceptions, attention, memory, awareness, judgment, and understanding of their condition.

Mental Status Testing

A structured assessment of appearance, behavior, alertness, orientation, attention, memory, language, thought, perception, mood, insight, and judgment.

Mentation

The process of thinking, perceiving, reasoning, and other mental activity.

Menthol

A mint-derived or synthetic compound producing a cooling sensation and used in some topical and respiratory preparations.

Menthol Poisoning

Poisoning after swallowing, inhaling, or having substantial skin exposure to menthol. It may cause nausea, abdominal pain, dizziness, drowsiness, agitation, seizures, coma, or breathing problems.

Mepacrine

An older antimalarial and antiprotozoal medicine, also called quinacrine, now used only in selected indications.

Meperidine

An opioid analgesic, also called pethidine, whose use is limited by adverse effects and an active neurotoxic metabolite.

Meperidine Hydrochloride

Meperidine hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of the opioid analgesic meperidine. It produces analgesia through opioid-receptor activity and carries risks of sedation, respiratory depression, seizures, dependence, and serotonin toxicity with interacting drugs.

Meperidine Hydrochloride Overdose

Taking too much meperidine hydrochloride, an opioid, can cause extreme sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or stopped breathing, low blood pressure, seizures, or coma. Delayed toxicity and serotonin toxicity are possible, so emergency assessment is required.

Mephenesin

An older centrally acting muscle relaxant with sedative effects. It is rarely used now and can impair alertness, coordination, and breathing when combined with other sedatives.

Mephentermine

A stimulant medicine formerly used in selected situations to raise dangerously low blood pressure. It increases activity of certain adrenaline-like receptors and can cause fast heartbeat, anxiety, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Mephenytoin

Mephenytoin is a hydantoin anticonvulsant formerly used to treat seizures. It is metabolized partly to ethotoin and has limited modern use because of potentially serious adverse effects, including hypersensitivity and blood dyscrasias.

Mepivacaine

A local anesthetic medicine that temporarily blocks pain signals from nerves. It is injected for numbing skin, dental areas, individual nerves, or larger body regions during procedures.

Meprobamate

An older medicine that reduces anxiety and causes sleepiness. It can cause dependence, dangerous breathing and nervous-system depression, and overdose, especially with alcohol or other sedatives, so it is rarely used today.

Meprobamate Overdose

Taking too much meprobamate can cause severe drowsiness, confusion, poor coordination, low blood pressure, slowed breathing, coma, or death. Alcohol and other sedatives increase the danger.

Mepyramine

An antihistamine that blocks H1 receptors and may cause sedation.

Alternate Names:
Pyrilamine

Meralgia Paresthetica

Burning, tingling, or numbness over the outer thigh caused by compression of the lateral femoral cutaneous nerve.

Alternate Names:
Burning Thigh Pain; Bernhardt-Roth Syndrome

Merbromin Poisoning

Poisoning from merbromin, an older mercury-containing antiseptic. Swallowing or repeated exposure may injure the mouth, stomach, kidneys, or nervous system; the amount and route determine risk and require poison-control or medical assess-

ment.

Mercaptopurine

A thiopurine antimetabolite used in selected leukemias and inflammatory disorders, requiring monitoring for marrow and liver toxicity.

Mercurialism

Long-term poisoning caused by mercury exposure. It may damage the nervous system, kidneys, digestive tract, mouth, or mental health, with effects depending on the mercury form, dose, and exposure duration.

Mercuric Chloride Poisoning

Severe poisoning from mercuric chloride, a corrosive inorganic mercury salt. It can burn the mouth and digestive tract and cause vomiting, bloody diarrhea, shock, kidney failure, or neurologic injury; emergency treatment is required.

Mercuric Oxide Poisoning

Poisoning from mercuric oxide, an inorganic mercury compound that can irritate or burn tissues and damage the kidneys and nervous system. Swallowing or inhalation can cause severe poisoning.

Mercury

A metal used in some industrial and laboratory products. Its chemical symbol is Hg; mmHg denotes millimeters of mercury, a unit of pressure. Exposure can harm the nervous system, kidneys, lungs, or digestive tract, so it must be handled and disposed of safely.

Alternate Names:
Hg

Mercury Poisoning

Illness caused by exposure to elemental, inorganic, or organic mercury. Effects depend on the form and dose and may include nerve, kidney, lung, or digestive injury; severe exposure can cause lasting harm.

Meridian

A reference line or plane; in traditional acupuncture it denotes a proposed pathway for qi, while in anatomy it may describe a longitudinal line.

Merkel Cell Carcinoma

A rare, fast-growing neuroendocrine cancer of the skin. It often appears as a firm, painless red, purple, or skin-colored lump, usually on sun-exposed skin. Some cases are associated with Merkel cell polyomavirus; others are linked to ultraviolet damage. Older age and a weakened immune system increase risk.

Alternate Names:
MCC; Neuroendocrine Carcinoma of the Skin

Merkel Cells

Specialized touch-sensing cells in the deepest layer of the skin that help detect light touch and sustained pressure.

Mermaid Syndrome

An extremely rare congenital anomaly in which the legs are fused to varying degrees, also called sirenomelia.

Meropenem

Meropenem is a broad-spectrum carbapenem antibiotic that inhibits bacterial cell-wall synthesis and treats severe susceptible infections, including meningitis; allergy, gastrointestinal effects, seizures, and resistance are possible.

Meropenem-Vaborbactam

An intravenous antibiotic combination used for some serious infections caused by bacteria resistant to many other antibiotics. The choice depends on laboratory susceptibility testing, infection site, kidney function, and local guidance.

MERRF Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder affecting how cells produce energy. It commonly causes muscle jerks, seizures, balance problems, and muscle weakness, and may also affect hearing, vision, or other organs.

MERS-CoV

Middle East respiratory syndrome coronavirus, the virus that causes MERS. Infection can cause fever and respiratory illness ranging from mild disease to severe pneumonia, especially in people with other health conditions.

Merthiolate Poisoning

Poisoning from merthiolate, commonly referring to the mercury-containing antiseptic thimerosal. Small skin exposures usually cause local irritation, but swallowing or repeated exposure may cause corrosive, kidney, or neurologic injury.

Merycism

Rumination, the repeated regurgitation and rechewing of food after eating.

Mesalamine

Mesalamine, or 5-aminosalicylic acid, is an anti-inflammatory drug used to induce and maintain remission in ulcerative colitis and some other inflammatory bowel conditions. It acts mainly topically in the intestinal mucosa and can rarely affect renal function.

Mesangial Cell

Specialized contractile pericyte-like cells located in the central stalk (mesangium) of the renal glomerulus between capillary loops, responsible for phagocytosing macromolecules, synthesizing mesangial matrix, and contracting in response to angiotensin II to regulate glomerular capillary filtration surface area.

Mesangiolysis

Mesangiolysis is dissolution or disruption of the mesangial tissue within a renal glomerulus. It may occur in severe endothelial injury and can be associated with microvascular lesions and glomerular capillary aneurysmal changes.

Mesangium

The mesangium is the supportive tissue between glomerular capillary loops, composed of mesangial cells and extracellular matrix. Mesangial cells provide structural support, regulate capillary flow, and clear certain substances; abnormal expansion occurs in several glomerular diseases.

Mescaline

A naturally occurring psychedelic substance found in certain cacti that alters perception and may cause hallucinations and autonomic effects.

Mesencephalon

The mesencephalon, or midbrain, is the part of the brainstem between the pons and diencephalon. It contains pathways and nuclei involved in eye movements, motor control, arousal, and auditory and visual reflexes.

Mesenchymal Cell

A connective-tissue precursor that can develop into bone, cartilage, fat, muscle, or tendon cells.

Mesenchymal Chondrosarcoma

Mesenchymal chondrosarcoma is a rare aggressive cancer containing cartilage-forming tissue, often arising in bone or soft tissue.

Mesenchymal CNS Tumor

A rare tumor arising from connective or supporting tissue in or around the brain or spinal cord rather than from nerve cells. Its behavior is determined by examination of tissue, imaging, and sometimes genetic testing.

Mesenchyme

Embryonic connective tissue that gives rise to much of the skeleton, connective tissue, blood vessels, and smooth muscle.

Mesenchymoma

A mesenchymoma is a rare tumor containing more than one type of mesenchymal tissue, sometimes including cartilage, bone, fat, or vascular elements. Behavior depends on the site, age, histology, and presence of malignant components.

Mesenteric

Relating to the mesentery, a fold of tissue supporting the intestines. It contains blood vessels, nerves, lymph vessels, and fat that help supply, drain, anchor, and protect the intestines.

Mesenteric Angiography

Contrast imaging of the arteries supplying the intestines, used to evaluate mesenteric ischemia, bleeding, aneurysm, stenosis, occlusion, or vascular anatomy.

Mesenteric Artery

A mesenteric artery supplies blood to portions of the intestine and associated abdominal organs. The superior and inferior mesenteric arteries are the major vessels; obstruction or embolism can cause acute mesenteric ischemia.

Mesenteric Artery Aneurysm

An abnormal bulge in an artery supplying the intestines. It may cause no symptoms, but rupture can cause severe internal bleeding, and clotting or reduced blood flow can injure the bowel.

Mesenteric Artery Ischemia

Inadequate blood flow through the mesenteric arteries, usually caused by embolism, thrombosis, or severe low-flow states. Acute disease presents with severe abdominal pain out of proportion to examination and can progress to bowel infarction.

Mesenteric Artery Occlusion

A blockage in an artery that carries blood to the intestines. It may be caused by a blood clot or severe narrowing. A sudden blockage can quickly cut off blood flow to the bowel and cause a life-threatening emergency called acute mesenteric ischemia.

Mesenteric Cyst

A rare, usually noncancerous, fluid-filled sac in the tissue that supports the intestines. Small cysts may cause no symptoms, while larger ones can cause swelling, pain, infection, twisting, or bowel blockage. Imaging helps locate the cyst, and treatment depends on its size, symptoms, and cause.

Mesenteric Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to the intestines, usually from a blocked or narrowed blood vessel. Sudden blockage may cause severe abdominal pain, often with little tenderness at first, nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, or bloody stool, and is a medical emergency. Long-term narrowing may cause cramping pain after meals, fear of eating, and weight loss. Severe or untreated disease can lead to bowel death, infection, or shock.

Mesenteric Lymphadenitis

Inflammation of lymph nodes in the tissue supporting the intestines, often after a viral or bacterial infection. It can cause right-sided abdominal pain, fever, nausea, and tenderness and may resemble appendicitis.

Alternate Names:
Mesenteric Adenitis

Mesenteric Lymph Nodes

Lymph nodes in the tissue that supports the intestines. They filter lymph from the bowel and help the immune system respond to infection or other abnormal changes.

Mesenteric Veins

Mesenteric veins drain blood from the small and large intestines and carry it mainly through the superior and inferior mesenteric veins to the portal venous system. Thrombosis or impaired flow can cause intestinal congestion and ischemia.

Mesenteric Venous Thrombosis

A blood clot in a mesenteric vein that impairs intestinal venous drainage and can cause abdominal pain, bowel edema, ischemia, infarction, or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Mesentery

A fold of the abdominal lining that attaches the intestines to the back wall of the abdomen. It carries blood vessels, nerves, and lymph vessels to the bowel and helps hold the intestines in place.

Mesh

A sheet-like implant made from synthetic or biological material that reinforces weakened tissue. It may be used in selected hernia or pelvic-floor operations; possible problems include pain, infection, scarring, movement of the implant, or injury to nearby organs.

Mesial

Located toward the body's midline; in dentistry, located toward the front or midline of a tooth. The term helps describe tooth surfaces, positions, cavities, gum disease, and dental restorations.

Mesial Surface

The mesial surface is the surface of a tooth or other structure oriented toward the midline. In dentistry, mesial surfaces contact adjacent teeth and can be involved in caries, periodontal disease, or restoration margins.

Mesna

A protective medicine given with certain chemotherapy drugs to reduce irritation and bleeding of the bladder. It binds harmful breakdown products in the urine and does not treat the cancer itself.

Mesoderm

The middle germ layer in an embryo, which develops into muscles, bones, cartilage, blood vessels, and the kidneys.

Mesometrium

The portion of the broad ligament of the uterus that extends from the lateral uterus toward the pelvic wall and contains associated vessels, nerves, and connective tissue.

Mesonephric

Mesonephric means relating to the mesonephros, a temporary embryonic kidney, or to structures derived from its ducts and tubules. Mesonephric remnants can give rise to uncommon benign or malignant lesions of the genital tract.

Mesonephric Adenocarcinoma

A rare HPV-independent cervical adenocarcinoma arising from mesonephric remnants, usually presenting as a cervical mass or abnormal bleeding and requiring histopathologic diagnosis.

Mesonephric Tumor

A mesonephric tumor is a rare tumor arising from remnants of embryonic mesonephric ducts, usually in the female reproductive tract.

Mesothelial Neoplasm

A mesothelial neoplasm is a growth arising from the lining of body cavities, such as the pleura, peritoneum, or pericardium.

Mesothelin

Mesothelin is a cell-surface glycoprotein expressed mainly by mesothelial cells and overexpressed in several cancers, including mesothelioma and some ovarian and pancreatic cancers. It is being studied as a biomarker and therapeutic target.

Mesothelioma

A cancer arising from the thin lining of body cavities, most often the pleura around the lungs. It is strongly associated with asbestos exposure and may cause chest pain, breathlessness, or fluid around the lung.

Mesothelium

The mesothelium is a single layer of specialized cells lining serous body cavities and covering their organs, including the pleura, peritoneum, and pericardium. It produces lubricating fluid and participates in inflammation and repair.

Messenger RNA

A temporary copy of genetic instructions made from DNA. It carries those instructions to cell structures that build proteins and is then broken down; some vaccines use messenger RNA to teach the immune system to recognize a target.

Met

Abbreviation for methionine, an essential sulfur-containing amino acid; it is also represented by the one-letter code M and the codons AUG.

Metabolic

Relating to metabolism, the chemical processes by which cells produce and use energy and materials.

Metabolic Acidosis

An acid-base imbalance in which too much acid accumulates in the body, or too much bicarbonate (a base) is lost, causing the blood to become excessively acidic. It can be caused by increased production of metabolic acids (such as in uncontrolled diabetes or severe oxygen deprivation), kidney failure preventing normal acid excretion, or loss of bicarbonate from severe, prolonged diarrhea.

Metabolic Alkalosis

An acid-base imbalance in which the blood becomes abnormally alkaline due to an excess of bicarbonate or an excessive loss of hydrogen ions (acid). It most commonly occurs after prolonged vomiting or stomach suctioning, which removes large amounts of stomach acid, or from the use of certain diuretic medications that cause the kidneys to lose fluid and electrolytes.

Metabolic Bone Disease

A group of disorders in which abnormal handling of calcium, phosphate, vitamin D, parathyroid hormone, or other factors weakens or changes bone. Examples include osteomalacia, rickets, and some disorders caused by kidney or endocrine disease.

Metabolic Bone Disease of Prematurity

Reduced bone mineral density and defective postnatal skeletal mineralization in very-low-birth-weight or extremely preterm infants. Results from inadequate accretion of calcium, phosphorus, and vitamin D typically transferred during the third trimester, exacerbated by prolonged total parenteral nutrition or diuretic therapy.

Alternate Names:
Osteopenia of Prematurity; Metabolic Bone Disease in Preterm Infants

Metabolic Disease

A disorder that changes how the body processes or uses substances such as sugars, fats, proteins, minerals, or hormones. It may be inherited or acquired and can affect energy, growth, blood chemistry, or organ function.

Metabolic Disorders

Alternate plural form; see *Metabolic Disease*.

Metabolic Dysfunction

Impairment in one or more biochemical processes by which the body produces, stores, or uses energy and materials. The phrase is descriptive rather than a single diagnosis; its meaning depends on the affected pathway and clinical context, such as glucose or lipid metabolism.

Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis

A form of metabolic dysfunction-associated steatotic liver disease (MASLD) in which liver fat is accompanied by inflammation and liver-cell injury, with or without fibrosis. It was formerly called nonalcoholic steatohepatitis (NASH).

Alternate Names:
MASH; Nonalcoholic Steatohepatitis (historical name)

Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)

Alternate name; see *Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis*.

Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease

A condition in which fat builds up in the liver in the presence of at least one cardiometabolic risk factor, such as obesity, type 2 diabetes, or abnormal blood fats. It includes simple steatosis and steatohepatitis (MASH) and was formerly called nonalcoholic fatty liver disease (NAFLD).

Alternate Names:

MASLD; Nonalcoholic Fatty Liver Disease (historical name)

Metabolic Equivalent of Task

A physiological measure expressing the energy cost of physical activities, defined as the ratio of metabolic rate during activity to resting metabolic rate, standardized as the consumption of 3.5 mL of oxygen per kilogram of body weight per minute (1 MET).

Alternate Names:
MET

Metabolic Equivalents

Units that compare the energy used during an activity with the energy used while resting. They provide a rough estimate of exercise intensity, but actual energy use varies between people.

Alternate Names:
METs

Metabolic Myopathies

Muscle disorders caused by impaired energy metabolism, often producing exercise intolerance, cramps, weakness, muscle pain, or episodes of rhabdomyolysis.

Metabolic Neuropathies

Nerve damage caused by a metabolic or systemic disorder, such as diabetes, kidney failure, vitamin deficiency, or an inherited metabolic disease. Symptoms commonly include numbness, burning pain, tingling, weakness, or problems with balance.

Metabolic Rate

The speed at which the body uses energy to keep organs working and support activity. It changes with body size, age, muscle amount, hormones, illness, temperature, food intake, and exercise.

Metabolic Response

A metabolic response is a change in energy use, substrate metabolism, or biochemical pathways in response to conditions such as fasting, exercise, infection, trauma, or medication. The response may be adaptive or contribute to illness when excessive or prolonged.

Metabolic Syndrome

A group of risk factors that raises the risk of cardiovascular disease and type 2 diabetes. It is diagnosed when at least three of these are present: increased waist circumference, high blood pressure, high blood glucose, high triglycerides, or low HDL cholesterol. Cutoffs for waist size and some laboratory values vary by guideline and population.

Alternate Names:
Insulin Resistance Syndrome; Syndrome X

Metabolic Tumor Volume

The estimated amount of tumor tissue that shows increased activity on a PET scan. It can help measure disease burden and treatment response, especially in lymphoma, but inflammation and scan technique can affect the result.

Metabolism

The chemical processes cells use to turn food and medicines into energy and building materials, and to break down substances the body no longer needs.

Metabolite

A substance made, changed, or used when the body processes a medicine, nutrient, or naturally occurring molecule. Measuring metabolites in blood or urine can show body function, disease, or drug effects.

Metabolomics

The comprehensive analysis of small molecules (metabolites) in a cell, tissue, biological fluid, or organism under defined conditions. Techniques such as mass spectrometry and nuclear magnetic resonance are used to characterize metabolic state and changes associated with disease, exposures, or treatment.

Metacarpal

One of the five cylindrical tubular long bones of the hand, numbered I through V from the radial (lateral) to ulnar (medial) aspect: first metacarpal

(thumb), second (index finger), third (middle finger), fourth (ring finger), and fifth (little finger). Anatomically each metacarpal features a concave proximal base articulating with the distal carpal bones (carpometacarpal joints) and adjacent metacarpals, an elongated longitudinally curved shaft providing attachment for the dorsal and palmar interosseous muscles, and a convex distal rounded head articulating with the proximal phalanges (metacarpophalangeal [MCP] joints). Metacarpal fractures are frequent orthopedic injuries, classically including the 'boxer fracture' (fracture of the neck of the fifth metacarpal from direct axial impact) and intra-articular fractures of the thumb metacarpal base (Bennett and Rolando fractures).

Metacarpal Bone

A metacarpal bone is one of the five long bones of the hand between the wrist bones and the proximal phalanges. Each has a base, shaft, and head; fractures can affect alignment, grip, and joint function.

Metacarpals

Plural form; see *Metacarpal*.

Metacarpophalangeal Joint

A knuckle joint connecting a palm bone to a finger or thumb bone. It allows the digit to bend, straighten, and move from side to side and can be injured by impact or twisting.

Metacarpophalangeal Joint Dislocation

Displacement of a finger or thumb's metacarpophalangeal joint, usually after trauma or forced hyperextension. Pain, deformity, swelling, and restricted movement occur; associated fractures, tendon injury, or neurovascular damage must be assessed.

Metacarpus

The part of the hand between the wrist and fingers, containing the five metacarpal bones.

Metachromatic Leukodystrophy

A rare inherited disorder in which harmful fatty substances build up in nerve cells and damage the protective covering of nerves. It causes worsening movement, thinking, speech, or vision problems, often beginning in childhood.

Metaflammation

Low-grade, persistent inflammation in metabolic tissues associated with excess nutrients and energy. It can involve adipose tissue, liver, muscle, pancreas, and other organs, and is linked to obesity-related insulin resistance and other metabolic dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Metabolic Inflammation; Metainflammation

Metagenomics

The analysis of genetic material, usually DNA, recovered directly from a mixed biological or environmental sample, typically to characterize the organisms present and the genes they carry without culturing each organism. Gene content can indicate a community's functional potential but does not by itself show which genes are active.

Metagenomics Test

A laboratory test that sequences genetic material in a patient sample to look for microbes without targeting a specific organism. Contamination or harmless microbes can affect results, and a negative result does not rule out infection.

Metagonimus Yokogawai

Metagonimus yokogawai is a small intestinal fluke acquired by eating raw or inadequately cooked freshwater fish. Infection can cause abdominal symptoms and, rarely, ectopic migration of eggs or adult worms.

Metal Artifact

Distortion or loss of detail on an X-ray, CT, or MRI image caused by metal such as an implant, clip, or bullet. It can hide nearby findings, so special imaging methods or another test may be needed.

Metal Fume Fever

A short-lived influenza-like illness caused by inhalation of fumes from heated metals, especially zinc; symptoms include fever, chills, headache, muscle aches, and cough.

Metalloendopeptidase

A metalloendopeptidase is an endopeptidase whose catalytic activity depends on a bound metal ion, commonly zinc. It cleaves peptide bonds within proteins and includes enzymes involved in extracellular matrix remodeling and signaling.

Metalloporphyrins

Metalloporphyrins are porphyrin molecules containing a centrally coordinated metal ion. Heme, which contains iron, is a biologically important example and forms the functional group of hemoglobin, myoglobin, and many enzymes.

Metalloprotease

A metalloprotease is a proteolytic enzyme that requires a metal ion, commonly zinc, for catalytic activity. Metalloproteases regulate extracellular matrix turnover, cell signaling, inflammation, and tissue remodeling; dysregulation contributes to disease.

Metalloprotein

A protein that contains a metal ion or binds one tightly as part of its structure or function. Iron, zinc, copper, and magnesium in metalloproteins support oxygen transport, enzyme activity, electron transfer, or regulation.

Metallothionein

Metallothionein is a small, cysteine-rich protein that binds metals such as zinc, copper, and cadmium. It helps regulate essential metals and may protect cells from metal toxicity and oxidative stress.

Metanephrine

Metanephrine is a metabolite of epinephrine formed mainly by catechol-O-methyltransferase. Plasma or urinary metanephrine measurements are used in evaluation for catecholamine-secreting tumors such as pheochromocytoma and paraganglioma.

Metaphase

The stage of cell division in which chromosomes align at the cell's equatorial plane.

Metaphase Plate

The metaphase plate is the plane at the center of a dividing cell where chromosomes align during metaphase. It is a geometric arrangement rather than a discrete anatomical structure.

Metaphyseal Corner Fractures

Small corner or bucket-handle breaks near the growth plates of an infant's long bones. They are highly concerning for forceful injury, especially when multiple or at different healing stages, but must be interpreted with the full medical and imaging assessment.

Metaphyseal Widening

Metaphyseal widening is enlargement of the growth-plate or metaphyseal region of a developing long bone. It may be seen in disorders such as rickets, skeletal dysplasia, infection, or healing injury and must be interpreted with imaging and clinical findings.

Metaphysis

The wider part of a growing long bone between its shaft and end. In children it lies next to the growth plate, where new bone forms and the bone lengthens.

Metaplasia

A usually reversible change in which one mature cell type is replaced by another that better tolerates ongoing irritation or stress. Some persistent forms may increase the risk of further abnormal changes.

Metaplastic Carcinoma

A cancer whose cells have changed to resemble a different type of tissue. The term is used especially for an uncommon, often aggressive breast cancer; diagnosis requires examination of a tissue sample.

Metapneumovirus

A respiratory virus that can cause cough, fever, bronchiolitis, or pneumonia, especially in infants, older adults, and people with chronic disease.

Metastasectomy

Surgery to remove one or more cancer deposits that have spread from the original tumor. It may help selected people when the deposits are limited and removable, but benefit depends on the cancer type, location, and other treatment options.

Metastases To The Breast

Secondary malignant deposits in breast tissue from a nonmammary primary tumor, most often melanoma, lymphoma, or carcinoma from another organ. Imaging and biopsy are needed because the treatment differs from primary breast carcinoma.

Metastasis

The spread of cancer from where it first started to another part of the body, where it forms a new tumor. Cancer cells can travel through the blood or lymph system. A tumor formed this way contains the same type of cancer as the original.

Metastasis-Free Survival

The length of time after treatment before cancer spreads to a distant part of the body or the person dies. Researchers use it to compare treatments and estimate how well they delay spread.

Metastasis Of Colorectal Cancer

Spread of cancer from the colon or rectum to another part of the body, most often the liver, lungs, or abdominal lining. Symptoms and treatment depend on the sites involved, number of tumors, and tumor test results.

Metastatic Adenocarcinoma

A gland-forming cancer that has spread from where it began to distant organs such as the liver, lungs, bones, or brain. Identifying the original site is important because treatment depends on its origin and spread.

Metastatic Brain Tumor

A metastatic brain tumor is cancer that has spread to the brain from a primary tumor elsewhere in the body.

Metastatic Breast Cancer

Breast cancer that has spread beyond the breast and nearby lymph nodes to distant sites, commonly bone, lung, liver, or brain. It may be present at first diagnosis or develop as a distant recurrence after earlier treatment; a tumor in another organ remains breast cancer. This is stage IV disease. Treatment may control the cancer and symptoms; choices depend on biopsy and biomarker results, disease sites, previous treatment, and the person's goals.

Metastatic Calcification

Deposition of calcium salts in previously normal tissues, usually when calcium and phosphate levels in blood are abnormally high. It may affect the kidneys, lungs, stomach, or blood vessels and impair their function.

Metastatic Cancer

Cancer that has spread from its original site to distant organs or tissues through the blood, lymphatic system, or body cavities. Many cancer types classify distant spread as stage IV, but staging rules vary by cancer. Metastatic tumors retain the features of the original cancer; for example, breast cancer that spreads to the lung remains metastatic breast cancer.

Metastatic Cervical Lymphadenopathy

Cancer that has spread from another site to one or more lymph nodes in the neck. A neck lump may be the first sign; the source of the cancer is assessed with examination and tests such as imaging or biopsy.

Metastatic Cancer With Unknown Primary Site

Cancer proven to have spread but for which the original primary tumor cannot be identified after appropriate evaluation. Pathology, immunohistochemistry, imaging, and molecular testing may suggest the origin and guide site-directed or empiric treatment.

Metastatic Bone Disease Of The Hip

Cancer that has spread to bone around the hip, such as the pelvis or upper thighbone. It may cause pain or weaken the bone enough to fracture; see also *Bone Metastases*.

Metastatic Castration-Resistant Prostate Cancer

Prostate cancer that has spread and continues growing despite treatment that lowers male hormones. Care may include hormone-targeting medicines, chemotherapy, radiation, immune treatment, or medicines for bone protection.

Metastatic Colon Cancer

Colon cancer that has spread beyond the bowel, most often to the liver, lungs, or abdominal lining. Symptoms and treatment depend on where it has spread, the tumor's genetic findings, and the person's overall health.

Metastatic Colorectal Cancer

Alternate name; see *Colorectal Cancer*.

Metastatic Inguinal Lymphadenopathy

Enlargement of lymph nodes in the groin because cancer cells have spread to them, often from the leg, genital area, lower abdomen, or anus. Examination and imaging help identify the original cancer and its extent.

Metastatic Lung Cancer

Lung cancer that has spread beyond the lungs to organs such as the brain, bones, liver, or adrenal glands. Treatment depends on the cancer type, molecular findings, areas affected, and overall health.

Metastatic Melanoma

Melanoma that has spread from its original site to nearby lymph nodes, skin or tissue along lymphatic pathways, or distant parts of the body. Distant spread may involve the lungs, liver, brain, bones, or distant lymph nodes.

Metastatic Pleural Tumor

A cancer deposit in the thin lining around the lung that has spread from another tumor, often from the lung, breast, or digestive tract. It may cause chest pain, breathlessness, or fluid around the lung.

Metastatic Spinal Tumor

Alternate name; see *Spinal Metastasis*.

Metastin

Metastin is an older name for kisspeptin, a peptide derived from the KISS1 gene. It stimulates hypothalamic gonadotropin-releasing hormone secretion and helps regulate puberty, reproductive function, and tumor-cell signaling.

Metatarsal

One of the five elongated long bones of the forefoot, designated I through V from the medial (great toe) to lateral (little toe) margin of the foot. Each metatarsal consists of a wedge-shaped proximal base articulating with the tarsal bones (medial, intermediate, and lateral cuneiforms, and cuboid at the tarsometatarsal or Lisfranc joint complex), a narrow longitudinally arched shaft that contributes to the medial and lateral longitudinal arches and transverse arch of the foot, and a rounded distal head that articulates with the proximal phalanges at the metatarsophalangeal (MTP) joints. Common clinical pathologies include stress fractures ('march fractures', typically involving the neck of the second or third metatarsal from repetitive mechanical loading), avulsion and transverse fractures of the fifth metatarsal base (pseudo-Jones and Jones fractures), and Freiberg disease (avascular necrosis of the second metatarsal head).

Metatarsal Bone

A metatarsal bone is one of the five long bones of the forefoot between the tarsal bones and proximal phalanges. Metatarsal fractures and alignment abnormalities can affect weight bearing and gait.

Metatarsalgia

Pain in the front or ball of the foot, often arising from pressure or irritation around the metatarsal

heads.

Metatarsals

Plural form; see *Metatarsal*.

Metatarsal Valgus

Metatarsal valgus is outward deviation of one or more metatarsal bones relative to the foot's normal axis. It may contribute to forefoot deformity and altered load distribution and is assessed clinically and radiographically.

Metatarsophalangeal Joint

A joint between a metatarsal bone of the foot and the first bone of a toe. It helps the toes bend and supports walking.

Metatarsus

The part of the foot between the tarsal bones and toes, containing the five metatarsal bones.

Metatarsus Adductus

A foot deformity in which the forefoot is angled inward relative to the hindfoot, often recognized in infancy and ranging from flexible to rigid.

Metatarsus Varus

Metatarsus varus is inward deviation of the forefoot caused by medial angulation of the metatarsal bones. It is often recognized in infancy and may be flexible or rigid; management depends on severity and persistence.

Metencephalon

The metencephalon is the embryonic brain region that develops into the pons and cerebellum. These structures participate in motor coordination, balance, cranial-nerve functions, and relay of signals between the brain and spinal cord.

Meteorism

Abdominal distension caused by excessive gas in the gastrointestinal tract.

Meter

A metric unit of length equal to 100 centimeters; medical usage may also refer to a measuring device.

Metered-Dose Inhaler

A pressurized inhaler that releases a measured amount of medicine as a spray. Correct timing and breathing are needed for the medicine to reach the lungs; a spacer can make use easier and improve delivery.

Metestrus

The stage of the reproductive cycle after ovulation in many mammals, when the corpus luteum develops and progesterone rises. The exact timing and biological features differ among species.

Metformin

A commonly used medicine for type 2 diabetes that lowers the amount of sugar made by the liver and helps the body use insulin better. Nausea or diarrhea are common; serious illness or severe kidney problems increase rare toxicity risk.

Metformin Hydrochloride

Metformin hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of metformin, an oral biguanide used chiefly for type 2 diabetes. It lowers blood glucose without directly stimulating pancreatic insulin release and is available in immediate- and extended-release formulations.

Metformin In Prediabetes

Metformin may reduce progression from prediabetes to type 2 diabetes, especially in people at high risk. Its use depends on age, body size, prior gestational diabetes, kidney function, other conditions, and patient preference; lifestyle intervention remains important.

Methacholine Challenge Test

A breathing test used when asthma is suspected but routine breathing tests are normal. The person inhales increasing amounts of methacholine, which can narrow sensitive airways; breathing is measured after each dose under medical supervision.

Methacholine Chloride

Methacholine chloride is a muscarinic cholinergic agonist used in bronchoprovocation testing. In susceptible people it causes airway narrowing, allowing assessment for bronchial hyperresponsiveness under controlled medical supervision.

Methadone

A long-acting opioid medicine used in selected pain cases and treatment of opioid-use disorder. It reduces withdrawal and cravings but can cause dangerous breathing suppression, sedation, dependence, or heart-rhythm changes.

Methadone Hydrochloride

Methadone hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of methadone. It provides long-lasting opioid-receptor activity for selected analgesic and opioid-use-disorder indications, with risks of respiratory depression, dependence, overdose, and cardiac arrhythmia.

Methadone Overdose

Taking too much methadone can cause profound sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or stopped breathing, coma, and death. Effects may be delayed or prolonged, and abnormal heart rhythms can occur.

Methaemoglobinaemia

A condition in which hemoglobin is changed so it cannot carry or release oxygen normally. It may cause blue or gray skin, headache, breathlessness, confusion, or severe oxygen shortage after exposure to certain medicines or chemicals.

Methamidophos

Methamidophos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause cholinergic poisoning with sweating, salivation, vomiting, bronchospasm, bradycardia, muscle weakness, and potentially respiratory failure.

Methamphetamine

A potent, highly addictive synthetic central nervous system sympathomimetic amine belonging to the substituted amphetamine class. Acts pharmacologically as a substrate for monoamine reuptake transporters—primarily the dopamine transporter (DAT), norepinephrine transporter (NET), and serotonin transporter (SERT)—as well as the vesicular monoamine transporter 2 (VMAT2). By reversing transporter directionality and disrupting vesicular storage, methamphetamine triggers massive, non-exocytotic efflux of dopamine and norepinephrine into the synaptic cleft, stimulating central reward pathways in the nucleus accumbens and activating the peripheral sympathetic nervous system. Acute physiological effects include intense euphoria, increased alertness, anorexia, tachycardia, severe arterial hypertension, hyperthermia, and pupillary dilation. Toxic overdose produces sympathomimetic toxidrome, malignant arrhythmias, hemorrhagic or ischemic stroke, acute myocardial infarction, seizures, and severe rhabdomyolysis. Chronic abuse causes neurotoxicity (depletion of striatal dopamine axons), severe paranoid psychosis, choreoathetoid movements, skin excoriations ('meth bugs' / formication), and rampant dental caries and periodontal decay ('meth mouth'). Management of acute toxicity centers on aggressive sedation with intravenous benzodiazepines, cooling for hyperthermia, and hemodynamic stabilization.

Methamphetamine Overdose

Taking too much methamphetamine can cause agitation, dangerously high temperature, fast heartbeat, high blood pressure, chest pain, seizures, stroke, abnormal rhythms, or severe confusion. It is a life-threatening poisoning.

Methamphetamines

Plural form; see *Methamphetamine*.

Methamphetamine Toxicity

Severe stimulant toxicity causing agitation, paranoia or psychosis, mydriasis, diaphoresis, tachycardia, hypertension, hyperthermia, seizures, myocardial ischemia, stroke, or rhabdomyolysis. Benzodiazepines, active cooling, ECG monitoring, and treatment of hyperthermia, seizures, ischemia, and complications are central.

Methane

Methane is a colorless, odorless, highly flammable gas produced by anaerobic decomposition and normal intestinal microbial activity. It can displace oxygen in enclosed spaces and cause asphyxiation; it is not itself a direct systemic poison at ordinary exposure levels.

Methane Sulfonate

Methane sulfonate, or mesylate, is the anion or ester derived from methanesulfonic acid. Mesylate salts are commonly used to improve the formulation of medicines; some methanesulfonate esters are potent alkylating agents and toxic impurities.

Methanobrevibacter Smithii

A methane-producing archaeon commonly found in the human intestine. It consumes hydrogen made by other gut microorganisms and may influence intestinal fermentation and gas production.

Methanol

A poisonous alcohol whose breakdown products can cause severe acid buildup, blindness, brain injury, or death. Serious poisoning can develop even before symptoms appear.

Methanol Poisoning

Poisoning by methanol, a type of alcohol found in some industrial products. Its breakdown can cause severe acid buildup, blindness, brain injury, or death, sometimes before symptoms appear.

Methanol Test

A blood test that measures methanol, a poisonous alcohol. It helps confirm toxic exposure, but treatment may begin before results because methanol can cause severe metabolic acidosis and delayed blindness or brain injury.

Methazolamide

Methazolamide is a carbonic anhydrase inhibitor used mainly to lower intraocular pressure in glaucoma. It reduces aqueous humor production and can cause metabolic acidosis, electrolyte abnormalities, kidney stones, or sulfonamide-related reactions.

Methemoglobin

Hemoglobin in which iron has been oxidized so it cannot carry oxygen normally. High levels cause methemoglobinemia, with cyanosis, headache, breathlessness, confusion, or severe tissue oxygen deficiency.

Methemoglobinemia

Methemoglobinemia occurs when hemoglobin iron is oxidized and cannot carry oxygen normally, causing cyanosis, headache, breathlessness, or severe tissue hypoxia.

Methenamine

Methenamine is a urinary antiseptic that decomposes in acidic urine to release formaldehyde, which inhibits bacterial growth. It is used for prevention of recurrent urinary tract infection in selected patients, not for treatment of active upper-tract infection.

Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus Aureus

A strain of Staphylococcus aureus that is resistant to several common antibiotics. It can cause skin, wound, lung, blood, bone, or other infections, and treatment is chosen using the infection site and laboratory testing.

Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus Aureus Infection

Alternate name; see *MRSA Infection*.

Methidathion

Methidathion is an organophosphorus insecticide and acaricide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can produce a cholinergic toxidrome with secretions, bronchospasm, bradycardia, gastrointestinal symptoms, weakness, and respiratory failure.

Methimazole

A medicine that reduces production of thyroid hormones and is used mainly for hyperthyroidism and Graves disease. It can rarely cause severe low white-cell counts or liver injury; fever or sore throat during treatment needs prompt medical advice.

Methiocarb

Methiocarb is a carbamate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase reversibly. Poisoning causes excessive muscarinic and nicotinic cholinergic activity and may require urgent supportive care and antidotal treatment.

Methionine

An essential amino acid containing sulfur that the body uses to build proteins and make other substances. People must obtain it from food, and it can be converted into homocysteine and related compounds.

Methionine Enkephalin

Methionine enkephalin is an endogenous opioid pentapeptide that binds opioid receptors and participates in modulation of pain, stress, reward, and neuroendocrine function. It is one of the products of proenkephalin processing.

Methocarbamol

Methocarbamol is a centrally acting skeletal-muscle relaxant used with rest and physical measures for acute painful musculoskeletal conditions. It can cause drowsiness, dizziness, impaired coordination, and additive central nervous system depression.

Methohexital

Methohexital is an ultra-short-acting barbiturate anesthetic used for induction of general anesthesia and, in selected settings, procedural sedation. It depresses central nervous system activity and may cause respiratory or cardiovascular depression.

Methomyl

Methomyl is a carbamate insecticide that reversibly inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Poisoning produces cholinergic symptoms such as salivation, sweating, vomiting, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, and respiratory compromise.

Methotrexate

An antimetabolite that inhibits folate-dependent enzymes and is used in cancer and selected autoimmune or inflammatory disorders.

Methotrexate In Dermatology

An immunomodulatory antimetabolite used in selected inflammatory and autoimmune skin diseases, including psoriasis, eczema, and some connective-tissue disorders. Treatment requires attention to liver disease, blood counts, infection risk, drug interactions, and strict pregnancy precautions.

Methotrimeprazine

Methotrimeprazine, also called levomepromazine, is a phenothiazine with antipsychotic, sedative, antiemetic, and analgesic properties. It is used in some countries for psychiatric illness and palliative-care symptoms and can cause sedation, hypotension, and anticholinergic effects.

Methoxamine

Methoxamine is a predominantly alpha-adrenergic agonist that increases vascular tone and blood pressure. It has been used as a vasopressor for hypotension but is not a routine first-line agent in many current practice settings.

Methoxsalen

Methoxsalen is a psoralen that intercalates into DNA and, after exposure to UVA, forms cross-links that suppress abnormal lymphocyte or skin-cell activity. It is used with UVA phototherapy for selected skin diseases; photosensitivity and skin-cancer risk require precautions.

Methoxyflurane

A vapor medicine formerly used to cause general anesthesia and, in some settings, provide short-term pain relief. High or repeated exposure can damage the kidneys, so use requires careful medical supervision.

Methyclothiazide

Methyclothiazide is a thiazide diuretic that inhibits sodium and chloride reabsorption in the distal convoluted tubule. It is used for hypertension or edema and may cause hypokalemia, hyponatremia, hyperuricemia, and glucose intolerance.

Methyl Alcohol

Another name for methanol, a toxic alcohol that can cause severe acidosis and blindness.

Methylation

The addition of a methyl group to DNA, proteins, or other molecules. DNA methylation can affect gene activity, but its effects depend on the site and cellular context.

Methyl Bromide

Methyl bromide, or bromomethane, is a volatile fumigant and alkylating chemical. Inhalation can cause severe neurologic, respiratory, renal, and cardiovascular toxicity, including delayed seizures and pulmonary edema.

Methylcellulose

A plant-fiber product used as a bulk-forming laxative and as a thickener in medicines and foods. It absorbs water and adds bulk to stool; it can be unsafe when a bowel blockage is present.

Methyl Chloride

Methyl chloride, or chloromethane, is a volatile industrial gas formerly used in refrigerants and other applications. High-level inhalation exposure can depress the central nervous system and cause headache, ataxia, seizures, or cardiac effects.

Methyldopa

A blood-pressure medicine that acts in the brain to reduce nerve signals that tighten blood vessels. It is used in selected cases, including pregnancy, and may cause sleepiness, dizziness, or liver problems.

Methylene Blue

A medicine used mainly for serious methemoglobinemia, a condition in which blood cannot carry oxygen normally. It may be unsafe in some people with an inherited red-cell enzyme deficiency and can interact with certain antidepressants.

Methylene Blue Test

A test or procedure using methylene blue dye to trace fluid flow, identify a structure, or detect a leak or abnormal connection. The purpose depends on the body site; allergy and blood-related complications are uncommon but possible.

Methylene Chloride

Methylene chloride, or dichloromethane, is a volatile industrial solvent. Inhalation can cause central nervous system depression and metabolism to carbon monoxide can produce tissue hypoxia; high exposure may be fatal.

Methylenedioxymethamphetamine

3,4-Methylenedioxymethamphetamine, abbreviated MDMA and commonly called ecstasy or molly, is a psychoactive drug with stimulant and hallucinogenic effects that increases serotonergic signaling and can cause serious toxicity.

Methylergometrine

An ergot alkaloid that increases uterine contraction and may be used to control postpartum hemorrhage when appropriate.

Methyl Isocyanate

Methyl isocyanate is a highly volatile and reactive industrial chemical. Inhalation or eye and skin exposure can cause severe irritation, pulmonary edema, and delayed respiratory injury; it was the toxic agent in the Bhopal disaster.

Methylmalonic Acid Blood Test

A blood test measuring methylmalonic acid to help detect vitamin B12 deficiency, especially when the B12 result is borderline. Kidney impairment can also raise the result.

Methylmalonic Acidemia

An inherited metabolic disorder in which the body cannot properly process certain fats and proteins, causing methylmalonic acid to build up. Episodes may cause vomiting, dehydration, acidosis, low blood sugar, seizures, or developmental and kidney problems.

Methylmalonic Acid Level

The amount of methylmalonic acid measured in blood or urine. A high level can support vitamin B12 deficiency, especially when the B12 result is unclear, but kidney disease can also raise it.

Methylmalonic Aciduria

A disorder in which methylmalonic acid builds up in blood and urine, usually because of an inherited enzyme or vitamin B12-processing problem. It may cause vomiting, poor feeding, acidosis, developmental problems, kidney disease, or neurologic injury.

Methylmercury Compounds

Methylmercury compounds are organic mercury compounds that can accumulate in aquatic food chains and cross the blood–brain and placental barriers. Exposure primarily injures the nervous system and can impair fetal neurodevelopment.

Methylmercury Poisoning

Poisoning caused by methylmercury, usually through contaminated food. It primarily injures the nervous system and may cause numbness, poor coordination, vision or hearing changes, and impaired fetal brain development.

Methylmethacrylate

Methyl methacrylate is a volatile monomer used to make acrylic plastics and dental or orthopedic bone cement. Vapors may irritate the eyes and airways, and liquid exposure can cause dermatitis or sensitization.

Methylmorphine

Another name for codeine, an opioid medicine used for selected pain or cough indications. It can cause drowsiness, constipation, dependence, and dangerous breathing suppression, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Methylnaltrexone

Methylnaltrexone is a peripherally acting mu-opioid-receptor antagonist used to treat opioid-induced constipation when laxatives are insufficient. It generally preserves central analgesia but can cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, and rarely gastrointestinal perforation.

Methylnaltrexone Bromide

Methylnaltrexone bromide is the bromide salt of methylnaltrexone, a peripherally restricted opioid antagonist. It reverses opioid effects in the gastrointestinal tract and is used for opioid-induced constipation under indication-specific precautions.

Methyl Parathion

Methyl parathion is an organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can produce severe cholinergic poisoning with secretions, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

Methylphenidate

A stimulant medicine used mainly to treat attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder and narcolepsy, a condition causing excessive sleepiness. It affects brain chemicals involved in attention and alertness; reduced appetite, sleep problems, increased blood pressure, and misuse are possible risks.

Methylprednisolone

A synthetic glucocorticoid used to suppress inflammation and immune activity.

Methyl Salicylate Overdose

Taking too much methyl salicylate, found in some oils and pain-relief products, can cause salicylate poisoning with vomiting, ringing in the ears, rapid breathing, confusion, seizures, acidosis, or coma. Emergency assessment is needed.

Methyltestosterone

A synthetic androgen related to testosterone. It can affect sexual development and other androgen-sensitive tissues but may cause liver injury, adverse cholesterol changes, infertility, or virilization and is used only in selected medical situations.

Metoclopramide

A medicine that helps the stomach empty and relieves nausea and vomiting. It is used for selected digestive problems and treatment-related nausea; prolonged or high-dose use can cause involuntary movements and other nervous-system effects.

Metolazone

A water-removing medicine used for high blood pressure and swelling. It helps the kidneys remove salt and water and is often combined with another diuretic, but can disturb sodium, potassium, kidney function, or hydration.

Metolcarb

Metolcarb is a carbamate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase. Exposure may cause cholinergic poisoning with excessive secretions, gastrointestinal symptoms, bronchospasm, bradycardia, weakness, or respiratory compromise.

Metopic Ridge

A metopic ridge is a palpable or visible line along the forehead from fusion of the metopic suture; it may be normal or associated with trigonocephaly.

Metoprolol

Metoprolol is a relatively beta-1-selective blocker used for hypertension, angina, heart failure, rate control, and some post-infarction settings; bradycardia, hypotension, fatigue, and bronchospasm can occur.

Metric System

The metric system is a decimal system of measurement based on units such as the meter, kilogram, and liter. Modern medicine generally uses the International System of Units, with conventional units retained for some measurements.

Metritis

Inflammation or infection of the uterus, often after childbirth, miscarriage, abortion, or a uterine procedure. It may cause fever, lower abdominal pain, unusual discharge, bleeding, or tenderness and usually needs treatment.

Metronidazole

An antibiotic and antiparasitic medicine used for certain infections caused by bacteria that grow without oxygen and by some parasites. It can cause nausea or a metallic taste; nerve problems may occur with prolonged use.

Metronidazole-Associated Encephalopathy

A rare complication of prolonged or high-dose metronidazole therapy, causing cerebellar dysfunction (ataxia, dysarthria, nystagmus) and sometimes confusion or seizures. MRI may show T2-hyperintense lesions in the cerebellar dentate nuclei, corpus callosum splenium, and brainstem. Symptoms typically resolve with drug discontinuation.

Metronomic Chemotherapy

Cancer treatment given in frequent, usually smaller doses over a long period instead of occasional high doses. The goal is to slow cancer growth and sometimes its blood supply; use depends on the cancer and treatment plan.

Metrorrhagia

Uterine bleeding that occurs at unexpected times, including between menstrual periods. Causes include pregnancy, hormonal changes, fibroids, polyps, infection, medicines, and cancer. New, heavy, prolonged, or postmenopausal bleeding can have an underlying medical cause.

METs

Metabolic equivalents used to estimate activity intensity or energy use. One MET is approximately the energy used while resting; higher values indicate more demanding activity and help describe exercise capacity.

Alternate Names:
Metabolic Equivalents

Metyrapone

A medicine that blocks one step in the production of cortisol, a hormone made by the adrenal glands. It is used for selected hormone tests or treatment under specialist supervision because levels can change

quickly.

Metzenbaum Scissors

Fine, lightweight surgical scissors designed to separate and cut delicate soft tissue. Their relatively narrow blades are useful for careful dissection, but they are not intended for cutting hard material or heavy sutures.

Mevalonate Kinase Deficiency

An inherited autoinflammatory disorder caused by changes in the MVK gene. It can cause repeated fever attacks, swollen lymph nodes, abdominal pain, rash, joint pain, or mouth ulcers; the milder form is often called hyperimmunoglobulin D syndrome.

Mevinphos

Mevinphos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can rapidly cause cholinergic crisis, including bronchorrhea, bronchospasm, muscle weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

Mexacarbate

Mexacarbate is a carbamate insecticide that interferes with acetylcholinesterase. Toxic exposure may produce muscarinic and nicotinic cholinergic symptoms and requires prompt decontamination and medical evaluation.

Mexiletine

Mexiletine is an oral class IB antiarrhythmic and sodium-channel blocker used for selected ventricular arrhythmias and sometimes neuropathic pain. It can cause gastrointestinal and neurologic effects and may worsen or provoke arrhythmias in some patients.

Meyerozyma Guilliermondii

Meyerozyma guilliermondii is a yeast formerly classified as Candida guilliermondii. It is usually an environmental or colonizing organism but can cause opportunistic bloodstream or other infections, particularly in immunocompromised patients.

MF

Abbreviation; see *Mycosis Fungoides*.

MFS

Abbreviation; see *Myxofibrosarcoma*.

MG

Abbreviation; see *Myasthenia Gravis*.

MGUS

See *Monoclonal Gammopathy Of Undetermined Significance*.

MHC Molecule

A protein on the surface of a cell that displays small pieces of proteins to T cells. This helps the immune system recognize infected or abnormal cells and distinguish the body's own cells from foreign material.

Alternate Names:
Major Histocompatibility Complex Molecule

Mianserin

An antidepressant medicine used in some countries to treat depression. It changes signaling by several brain chemicals and can cause sleepiness, increased appetite, weight gain, dizziness, or other medicine-related effects.

MIBG Scan

A nuclear medicine scan that uses a small amount of radioactive MIBG to find certain tumors of nerve-related tissue. It is used especially for pheochromocytoma, paraganglioma, and neuroblastoma; medicines and thyroid protection may be needed before the scan.

MIBG Scintiscan

A nuclear medicine scan using radiolabeled metaiodobenzylguanidine to image tissues derived from the sympathetic nervous system, including selected pheochromocytomas, paragangliomas, and neuroblastomas.

Mica

A group of sheet silicate minerals; inhalation of mica dust can cause occupational lung disease.

Micafungin

An echinocandin antifungal agent used in the treatment and prophylaxis of invasive candidiasis and esophageal candidiasis. Micafungin inhibits beta-(1,3)-D-glucan synthase, disrupting fungal cell wall synthesis and leading to osmotic instability and cell death.

Micelle

A tiny cluster of molecules that helps carry fats and fat-soluble substances through intestinal fluid for absorption.

Michaelis-Menten Kinetics

A mathematical model describing the rate of enzyme-catalyzed reactions by relating reaction velocity (V) to substrate concentration ($[S]$), defined by the maximal velocity (V_{max}) and the Michaelis constant (K_m, the substrate concentration at half-maximal velocity).

Miconazole

An antifungal medicine used in creams, gels, or other preparations for infections of the skin, mouth, or vagina. It stops fungi from making an essential part of their outer covering; irritation and medicine interactions are possible, especially with some oral products.

Microabscess

A very small pocket of pus containing immune cells, damaged tissue, and sometimes germs. It may occur in the skin or an organ because of infection or inflammation and is usually a finding rather than a diagnosis.

Microalbuminuria

Older term for moderately increased albumin in the urine, usually an albumin-to-creatinine ratio of 30–299 mg/g (3–29 mg/mmol). It can indicate kidney or cardiovascular risk; fever, strenuous exercise, urinary infection, or other temporary conditions can raise urine albumin, so an abnormal result is usually confirmed with repeat testing.

Microalbuminuria Test

A urine test that measures albumin, usually as an albumin-to-creatinine ratio, to detect and monitor albuminuria. The older term *microalbuminuria* refers to a ratio of 30–299 mg/g (3–29 mg/mmol); repeat testing may be needed because temporary conditions can raise the result.

Microaneurysm

A very small balloon-like bulge in a blood vessel wall. In the retina, microaneurysms are an early sign of diabetic eye disease and may leak fluid, causing swelling and blurred vision. Their number and associated retinal changes help show how diabetes is affecting the eyes.

Microangiopathic Hemolysis

Destruction of red blood cells as they pass through damaged or narrowed small blood vessels. Blood tests may show fragmented cells, anemia, and other signs of red-cell breakdown; causes include severe high blood pressure, pregnancy complications, infection, and clotting disorders.

Microangiopathic Hemolytic Anemia

An anemia caused by mechanical fragmentation of red blood cells as they pass through damaged or narrowed small blood vessels, producing schistocytes and often elevated hemolysis markers.

Microangiopathy

Disease or damage affecting the body's smallest blood vessels. Thickened or injured vessel walls can reduce blood flow or allow leakage and may damage organs, especially in diabetes, high blood pressure, or clotting disorders.

Microarray

A laboratory test using a small chip covered with DNA probes. It can measure activity of many genes or find selected missing or extra DNA segments and is used mainly for specialized genetic or research testing.

Microarray Analysis

Microarray analysis measures the abundance or hybridization of many nucleic-acid sequences simultaneously using an array of immobilized probes. It can assess gene expression, copy-number changes, or selected genetic variants.

Microbacterium

A genus of gram-positive bacteria found in soil and water that can rarely cause bloodstream or other opportunistic infections.

Microbe

A microorganism, such as a bacterium, fungus, protozoan, or virus.

Alternate Names:
Microorganism

Microbial Biofilms

Microbial biofilms are organized communities of microorganisms attached to a surface and enclosed in a self-produced extracellular matrix. Biofilms can form on tissues and medical devices and often show increased tolerance to antimicrobials and host defenses.

Microbicide

A microbicide is a chemical or biological agent that kills microorganisms or inactivates them. The term may refer to disinfectants, topical agents, or investigational products intended to reduce sexual transmission of infection.

Microbiology

The study of microorganisms, including bacteria, viruses, fungi, and parasites, and how they interact with people, animals, plants, and the environment. In medicine, it supports the diagnosis, prevention, and treatment of infectious diseases.

Microbiome

The community of microorganisms and their genetic material living in a body site, especially the intestine. These organisms can influence digestion, immunity, and health, although the effects differ by person and condition.

Microcalcification

A very small calcium deposit in tissue. On a mammogram, its shape and arrangement may reflect normal change, injury, infection, or early breast cancer, so suspicious findings may require further imaging or biopsy.

Microcephaly

A head circumference at least 2 standard deviations below the mean for a person's age and sex, measured using an appropriate growth chart. It may result from genetic or developmental conditions, infection, toxic exposures, or injury, and does not by itself predict the degree of neurologic impairment.

Microcirculation

The movement of blood through the body's smallest blood vessels. In these vessels, oxygen and nutrients pass to tissues and waste products pass into the blood; poor microcirculation can slow healing and damage organs.

Microcolon

Microcolon is an abnormally small-caliber colon, often identified on contrast imaging. It may result from reduced fetal intestinal use or obstruction and is associated with conditions such as small-left-colon syndrome, meconium ileus, or distal intestinal obstruction.

Microcornea

Microcornea is an abnormally small cornea, usually defined in adults by a horizontal diameter below about 10 mm. It may be isolated or associated with microphthalmia, glaucoma, cataract, or genetic syndromes.

Microcurie

A microcurie (μCi) is a unit of radioactivity equal to one-millionth of a curie, or approximately 37 kilobecquerels. It may be used to express the activity of radioactive tracers or sources.

Microcystic Adnexal Carcinoma

A rare, slow-growing but locally aggressive malignant adnexal tumor, usually on the head or neck, with follicular and ductal differentiation; it may extend deeply and requires complete excision.

Microcytic Anemia

Anemia in which red blood cells are smaller than usual. Common causes include iron deficiency, thalassemia, long-term inflammation, lead exposure, and some bone-marrow disorders. Blood counts and iron tests help find the cause; symptoms may include tiredness, weakness, pale skin, or shortness of breath.

Alternate Names:
Microcytic Hypochromic Anemia; Small-Cell Anemia; Low-MCV Anemia

Microdermabrasion

A cosmetic treatment that gently removes the outermost layer of skin with fine crystals or a rough-tipped device. It may improve the look of mild uneven texture, dullness, or some marks, but can cause redness, irritation, infection, or temporary darkening.

Microdialysis

A testing method that uses a very small tube to collect chemicals from the fluid around cells. It can measure local levels of medicines or natural substances, including in the brain or beneath the skin.

Microdiscectomy

A spinal operation that removes part of a herniated disc pressing on a nerve, usually in the lower back. It may reduce pain, numbness, or weakness caused by nerve pressure. Possible complications include infection, bleeding, nerve injury, or a return of the disc problem.

Alternate Names:
Lumbar Microdiscectomy; Microdiskectomy; Minimally Invasive Discectomy

Microdissection

Microdissection is separation or isolation of very small tissue regions or structures under microscopic or highly magnified visualization. It is used in surgery, pathology, and molecular research to obtain selected cells or tissue.

Microdissection Testicular Sperm Extraction

A surgical procedure that uses a microscope to search the testicle for small areas making sperm. It may help some men with very low or absent sperm production obtain sperm for assisted reproduction. The procedure can cause pain, bleeding, infection, or reduced testicular function, and sperm may not be found.

Alternate Names:
Micro-TESE; Microsurgical TESE

Microdontia

Abnormally small teeth, which may affect one or several teeth and can be inherited or developmental.

Microfibril

A very small thread-like structure that supports tissues. In connective tissue, microfibrils help organize elastic fibers and provide strength; in plants, they are made mainly of cellulose.

Microfilament

A microfilament is a thin cytoskeletal filament composed mainly of actin, about 7 nm in diameter. Microfilaments support cell shape, motility, contraction, cytokinesis, and intracellular transport.

Microfilament Proteins

Proteins that make, organize, move, or regulate actin microfilaments. They help cells maintain shape, migrate, divide, contract, and transport materials; examples include actin, myosin, and actin-binding proteins.

Microfilaria

An early larval stage of a filarial worm, found in the blood or skin of an infected host. A blood-feeding insect may ingest microfilariae; they develop into infective larvae in the insect, which can then transmit infection during a later bite.

Microglandular Adenosis

Microglandular adenosis is an uncommon benign proliferation of small glands in the breast, often associated with hormonal influences such as pregnancy or progestin use. It can mimic invasive carcinoma and is diagnosed histologically.

Microglia

Microglia are resident immune cells of the central nervous system. They survey neural tissue, remove debris, and respond to injury or infection; persistent activation can contribute to neuroinflammation.

Microgliosis

Microgliosis is proliferation or increased activation of microglia in the central nervous system, usually in response to injury, infection, degeneration, or other inflammation. It is a histopathologic finding rather than a specific disease.

Micrognathia

Micrognathia is an unusually small lower jaw that may affect feeding, teeth, facial development, or airway breathing.

Micrognathism

Micrognathism is abnormal smallness of the jaw, usually referring to the mandible. It may be congenital or acquired and can affect feeding, dentition, airway patency, speech, or facial development.

Micrograms

A unit of mass equal to one millionth of a gram, written as mcg. It is commonly used for small medicine doses and nutrient amounts; confusing micrograms with milligrams can cause a serious dosing error.

Micrographia

Abnormally small handwriting, often becoming progressively smaller within a sentence. It commonly occurs in Parkinson disease and other movement disorders because of reduced movement size and control.

Microinjection

Microinjection is delivery of a very small volume of fluid into a cell, tissue, or other microscopic target using a fine needle or micropipette. It is used in assisted reproduction, experimental biology, and some therapeutic procedures.

Micrometastasis

A small group of cancer cells that has spread from the original tumor but is too small to detect on routine scans or examination. It may be found in tissue samples and can affect staging and treatment decisions.

Micrometer

An instrument or unit used to measure very small distances; one micrometer is one-millionth of a meter.

Micromolar

A concentration unit equal to one millionth of a mole per liter, written as $\mu\text{mol}/L$.

Micromole

A micromole (μmol) is an amount of substance equal to one-millionth of a mole, or approximately 6.022×10^{17} entities. It is commonly used for small quantities and concentrations of biochemical substances.

Micron

A unit measuring one-millionth of a meter, commonly used to describe the size of cells, bacteria, and particles.

Microneme

A microneme is a small secretory organelle in many apicomplexan parasites. It releases proteins that support host-cell attachment, motility, and invasion during the parasite life cycle.

Micronization

Micronization is a process that reduces particles to micrometer-scale dimensions, often to increase surface area and improve dissolution or absorption of

a drug. The resulting particle size and formulation still determine clinical performance.

Micronized

Processed into very small particles to improve dispersion or absorption.

Micronutrient

An essential chemical substance required by the human body throughout the lifespan in minute quantities (typically micrograms to milligrams per day) that cannot be synthesized endogenously in adequate amounts and must be obtained from dietary sources. Comprises essential vitamins (fat-soluble: A, D, E, K; and water-soluble: B-complex vitamins and vitamin C) and dietary trace minerals (iron, zinc, iodine, selenium, copper, manganese, fluoride, chromium, and molybdenum). Unlike macronutrients (carbohydrates, proteins, fats), micronutrients do not provide caloric energy, but function critically as obligate coenzymes, prosthetic groups, gene expression regulators, structural components of metalloenzymes, and cellular antioxidants essential for DNA synthesis, erythropoiesis, immune competence, bone mineralization, and neurological function. Specific deficiencies cause classic nutritional deficiency disorders: iron deficiency (anemia), vitamin C deficiency (scurvy), vitamin D deficiency (rickets / osteomalacia), vitamin A deficiency (xerophthalmia / night blindness), thiamine deficiency (beriberi / Wernicke-Korsakoff syndrome), and iodine deficiency (goiter and cretinism).

Micronutrients

Plural form; see *Micronutrient*.

Microorchidism

Abnormally small testes, which may result from impaired development, genetic syndromes, or testicular atrophy after injury or infection.

Microorganism

A microscopic living organism, such as a bacterium, fungus, protozoan, or alga; viruses are acellular infectious agents.

Microorganism Genetics

The study of genetic material, inheritance, variation, and gene activity in microorganisms. It helps explain how microbes grow, cause disease, develop drug resistance, and exchange useful or harmful traits.

Micropenis

An unusually small penis caused by inadequate androgen effect or other developmental conditions, defined clinically by a stretched penile length more than 2.5 standard deviations below the mean for age and population. Evaluation may identify endocrine or genetic causes.

Micro-PET

Small-animal positron emission tomography using a dedicated high-resolution scanner to image radiotracer distribution and biological processes in research animals, especially rodents. It is used in preclinical studies of disease, drug effects, and molecular targets, and is distinct from routine PET imaging in human patients.

Alternate Names:
MicroPET; Small-Animal PET

Microphallus

An abnormally small penis, also called micropenis, usually defined relative to age and developmental standards; it may reflect hormonal or developmental disorders.

Microphthalmia

A birth defect in which one or both eyes are smaller than usual. It may occur with other eye or genetic conditions and can reduce vision. Treatment depends on the cause and may include glasses, treatment for poor vision, or surgery.

Microphthalmos

A birth condition in which one or both eyeballs are unusually small. Vision may be reduced, and other eye or genetic problems may occur, so affected children need an eye examination and ongoing specialist care.

Microplastics

Very small plastic particles, generally less than five millimeters across, found in the environment and sometimes in food, water, and air. Human health effects are still being studied.

Micropolygyria with Muscular Dystrophy

A rare congenital syndrome combining abnormal folding of the cerebral cortex with muscular dystrophy, causing developmental, seizure, movement, and muscle weakness findings.

Micropsia

A change in vision in which objects appear smaller or farther away than they really are. It can occur with migraine, retinal disease, brain disorders, medicines, or other problems; new or persistent symptoms can be associated with neurologic or eye disease.

MicroRNA

A very small, non-coding RNA that helps control which genes are active, mainly by reducing the production of specific proteins. MicroRNAs are being studied as possible disease markers and treatment targets.

Microsatellite Instability

A tumor pattern in which short repeated DNA sequences gain or lose units because the cell's DNA repair system is faulty. A high level can occur in inherited or sporadic cancers and may help predict benefit from some immune treatments.

Microscope

An instrument that magnifies structures too small to see clearly with unaided eyes. Light, electron, and fluorescence microscopes help examine cells, tissues, blood, microbes, and other samples.

Microscopic

Visible only with a microscope or relating to microscopic examination.

Microscopic Anatomy

The study of cells, tissues, and fine structural details that require magnification for examination; it includes cytology and histology.

Microscopic Colitis

Long-lasting inflammation of the colon that usually causes frequent, watery, non-bloody diarrhea while the colon looks normal during routine colonoscopy. Tiny tissue samples are needed for diagnosis; the main forms are collagenous and lymphocytic colitis.

Microscopic Examination

Examination of cells or tissue with a microscope to look for normal structure, infection, inflammation, or cancer. The sample may be stained and assessed together with its visible appearance, imaging, and other laboratory results.

Microscopic Hematuria

Alternate name; see *Hematuria*.

Microscopic Polyangiitis

An autoimmune disease that inflames and damages small blood vessels. It can affect the kidneys, lungs, skin, nerves, or other organs and may cause blood in the urine, breathing problems, rash, weakness, or bleeding.

Microscopy

Microscopy is examination of cells, tissues, organisms, or materials with a microscope. Light, fluorescence, electron, and other microscopy methods provide different information about structure and composition.

Microsecond

A unit of time equal to one-millionth of a second.

Microspectrophotometry

Microspectrophotometry measures the absorption or emission spectrum of a microscopic region or individual cell. It can quantify pigments, nucleic acids, proteins, or other chromophores in small biological samples.

Microsphere

A microsphere is a small spherical particle, often made of polymer, glass, or another material, used in drug delivery, imaging, embolization, or laboratory assays. Its size, composition, and surface properties determine its biologic behavior.

Microspherophakia

Microspherophakia is an abnormally small, spherical crystalline lens. It can occur in inherited disorders such as Weill–Marchesani syndrome and may cause lens displacement, pupillary block, angle-closure glaucoma, or reduced vision.

Microsporidia

A group of microscopic spore-forming organisms related to fungi. They can cause prolonged diarrhea, eye disease, muscle disease, or widespread infection, especially in people with weakened immune systems.

Microsporidiosis

An infection caused by microsporidia, microscopic organisms related to fungi that produce resistant spores. It most often affects the intestine and may cause long-lasting diarrhea and weight loss. It can also affect the eyes, muscles, kidneys, brain, or several organs, especially in people with weakened immune systems.

Microsporum

Microsporum is a genus of dermatophyte fungi that can cause ringworm of the skin, scalp, or hair.

Microsporum Audouinii

Microsporum audouinii is a dermatophyte that mainly infects the scalp and can cause tinea capitis, especially in children.

Microsporum Distortum

Microsporum distortum is a rare dermatophyte related to M. canis that can cause skin or scalp infection.

Microsporum Ferrugineum

A fungus that can cause ringworm of the scalp or skin, particularly in children. Laboratory examination can help confirm the infection and distinguish it from other causes of rash or hair loss.

Microsporum Gypseum

Microsporum gypseum is a soil-associated dermatophyte that can cause ringworm of the skin or scalp.

Microstomia

Microstomia is abnormal narrowing or smallness of the mouth opening. It may be congenital or result from scarring, burns, surgery, trauma, or connective-tissue disease and can impair eating, speech, oral hygiene, and dental treatment.

Micro-Surgery

Surgery performed with magnification and fine instruments to repair very small structures such as nerves and vessels.

Microtechnology

Microtechnology is the design and manufacture of devices or structures with micrometer-scale features. Medical applications include microfluidic diagnostics, sensors, drug-delivery systems, and minimally invasive instruments.

Microtia

A birth defect in which the outer ear is smaller than usual or does not form fully. The ear canal may also be narrow or absent, which can reduce hearing.

Microtome

An instrument that cuts extremely thin slices of tissue for examination under a microscope. The slices are mounted on slides, stained, and studied to identify normal structures or disease.

Microtubule

A tiny hollow protein tube inside a cell. Microtubules help maintain cell shape, move materials within the cell, support cell division, and form part of cilia and other moving structures.

Microtubule Bundle

A microtubule bundle is an organized group of parallel or otherwise coordinated microtubules within a cell. Bundles provide structural support and guide transport or movement, including in axons, cilia, and dividing cells.

Microvascular

Relating to the body's smallest blood vessels, including tiny arteries, capillaries, and veins. These vessels deliver oxygen and nutrients, remove waste, and control blood flow through tissues.

Microvascular Disease

Disease affecting the body's smallest blood vessels, which can reduce blood flow and oxygen delivery to organs or tissues. Diabetes, high blood pressure, smoking, inflammation, and aging can damage these vessels.

Microvasculature

The network of the body's smallest blood vessels, including tiny arteries, capillaries, and veins. It delivers oxygen and nutrients, removes waste, controls tissue blood flow, and helps regulate fluid movement between blood and tissues.

Microvilli

Tiny finger-like projections on the surface of cells. In the small intestine, they increase the area available for absorbing nutrients.

Microvillus

A microvillus is a microscopic, actin-supported projection of a cell membrane that increases surface area. Microvilli are abundant on intestinal epithelial cells, where they support nutrient absorption, and on renal tubular cells.

Microvolt

A microvolt (μV) is one-millionth of a volt. It is used to express small bioelectric signals, such as those recorded by electroencephalography, electromyography, electrocardiography, or evoked-potential testing.

Microwave Ablation

A procedure that uses microwave energy to heat and destroy selected tissue, usually under imaging guidance.

Microwave Therapy

Treatment that uses microwave energy to heat or destroy selected tissue. It has specialized uses, such as treating some tumors or controlling bleeding, and the risks depend on the body area and device used.

Micturition

The process of passing urine. The bladder squeezes while the muscles at its outlet relax, under coordinated control from the brain and nerves.

Midaxillary Line

An imaginary vertical line on the side of the body passing through the apex of the axilla (armpit).

Midazolam

Midazolam is a short-acting benzodiazepine used for procedural sedation, anesthesia, and treatment of acute seizures in appropriate settings. It enhances GABA-A receptor activity and can cause profound sedation and respiratory depression, especially with opioids or other depressants.

Midazolam Hydrochloride

Midazolam hydrochloride is the hydrochloride salt of the short-acting benzodiazepine midazolam. It is used for procedural sedation, anesthesia, and selected seizure emergencies and can cause dose-related sedation, hypotension, and respiratory depression.

Midbrain

The upper part of the brainstem, between the lower brainstem and the main brain. It helps control eye movements, movement, alertness, and automatic responses to sights and sounds.

Midclavicular Line

An imaginary vertical line on the front of the body passing through the midpoint of the clavicle (collar-

bone).

Middle Ear

An air-filled space between the eardrum and inner ear that contains the malleus, incus, and stapes. These ossicles transmit sound vibrations to the inner ear, and the auditory tube helps equalize middle-ear pressure.

Middle Ear Implant

An implanted hearing device that electrically or mechanically stimulates middle-ear structures to improve sound transmission in selected hearing loss. It differs from a cochlear implant, which directly stimulates the inner-ear auditory nerve pathway.

Middle Ear Infection

Infection or inflammation in the space behind the eardrum. It often follows a cold and may cause ear pain, fever, temporary hearing loss, fluid behind the eardrum, or irritability in children.

Middle East Respiratory Syndrome

A respiratory infection caused by Middle East respiratory syndrome coronavirus (MERS-CoV), usually linked to close contact with infected camels or people. It may cause fever, cough, pneumonia, breathing failure, or kidney and other organ problems.

Alternate Names:
MERS; Camel Flu

Middle Insomnia

Middle insomnia is repeated or prolonged awakening during the middle portion of the sleep period, often with difficulty returning to sleep. It may occur with stress, mood disorders, sleep apnea, pain, substances, medications, or other sleep disorders.

Middle Lobe Syndrome

Chronic or recurrent atelectasis and infection of the right middle lobe due to bronchial obstruction. The long, narrow right middle lobe bronchus is susceptible to compression by lymph nodes, tumors, or mucous plugging. It may be caused by bronchiectasis, malignancy, or granulomatous disease. Treatment depends on the underlying cause.

Middle Mediastinum

The central part of the lower mediastinum that contains the heart, pericardium, roots of the great vessels, and phrenic nerves.

Mid-Dorsal

Situated in the middle region of the back or on the dorsal side of a structure.

Mid-Forearm

The middle part of the forearm, between the elbow and wrist. Measurements or injections described as mid-forearm use this region as a reference point.

Mid-Gut

The embryonic middle portion of the primitive gut, which develops into much of the small intestine and proximal colon.

Midgut Volvulus

A life-threatening twisting of the intestine that can cut off its blood supply, usually because the intestine formed abnormally before birth. Babies may suddenly develop green vomiting, a swollen or painful abdomen, blood in the stool, or extreme illness. It is an emergency requiring immediate imaging and surgery to untwist and protect the bowel.

Alternate Names:
Midgut Torsion

Mid-Leg

The central part of the lower limb between the knee and ankle. It contains the shin bones, muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and soft tissues that support walking and ankle movement.

Mid-Line

The imaginary or anatomical line dividing a structure or body into right and left portions.

Midomafetamine

Midomafetamine is another name for 3,4-methylenedioxymethamphetamine, a psychoactive amphetamine derivative. It is being studied in controlled psychotherapy-assisted research but can

cause hyperthermia, hyponatremia, cardiovascular toxicity, serotonin toxicity, and misuse.

Midostaurin

Midostaurin is a multikinase inhibitor used with chemotherapy for newly diagnosed acute myeloid leukemia with a susceptible FLT3 mutation and for advanced systemic mastocytosis. It can cause nausea, cytopenias, infection, and other treatment-related toxicities.

Midriff

Alternate informal term; see *Abdomen*.

Midsagittal Plane

A vertical plane passing through the midline that divides the body or a structure into equal right and left halves.

Mid-Stream Urine Specimen

A urine sample collected after initial urine is voided, reducing contamination from the urethral opening and used commonly for culture.

Mid-Systolic Click

A sharp heart sound heard during the middle or later part of the heartbeat, often associated with mitral-valve prolapse. It may be followed by a murmur if the valve allows blood to leak backward.

Midtrimester

The middle part of pregnancy, usually covering about weeks 14 through 27. During this period the fetus grows rapidly, routine anatomy screening is often performed, and pregnancy symptoms and risks vary from person to person.

Mid-Upper-Arm Circumference

The circumference of the upper arm measured at the midpoint between the acromion and olecranon processes. It is a practical anthropometric measure of muscle and fat stores, particularly useful when body weight or height cannot be measured reliably.

Midwife

A trained and regulated professional who provides care during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postnatal period.

Midwifery

The professional practice of supporting and managing normal pregnancy, childbirth, postpartum recovery, and newborn care.

Mifepristone

Mifepristone is a progesterone-receptor antagonist and, at higher doses, a glucocorticoid-receptor antagonist. It is used with misoprostol for medication abortion under applicable protocols and for selected cases of hyperglycemia associated with Cushing syndrome.

Migraine

A recurring neurological disorder that causes attacks of moderate to severe, often throbbing or pulsing head pain. The pain may occur on one or both sides of the head and may be accompanied by nausea, vomiting, or increased sensitivity to light, sound, or smells. Some people have an aura, such as flashing lights, blind spots, tingling, numbness, or temporary speech problems, which usually develops gradually and resolves completely. Migraine attacks may last from several hours to a few days, and some occur with little or no headache.

Alternate Names:
Migraine Headache; Hemicrania

Migraine And Stroke Symptoms

Migraine aura usually develops gradually and resolves, whereas stroke symptoms often begin suddenly and cause persistent focal deficits such as weakness, speech trouble, facial droop, or vision loss. Sudden or atypical neurologic symptoms can indicate stroke.

Migraine Headaches

Alternate name; see *Migraine*.

Migraine With Aura

A primary headache disorder marked by at least two attacks with fully reversible visual, sensory, speech, or other neurologic symptoms (aura). Aura symptoms often spread gradually; each individual symptom usually lasts 5–60 minutes. Headache commonly accompanies or follows the aura within an hour, but aura can occur without headache.

Migraine Without Aura

A primary headache disorder marked by recurrent attacks lasting 4–72 hours. The headache has at least two features such as one-sided location, pulsating quality, moderate or severe intensity, or worsening with routine activity, and is accompanied by nausea or vomiting, or by both light and sound sensitivity.

Migrainous Neuralgia

Older term; see *Cluster Headache*.

Migrating Motor Complex

Repeating waves of muscle activity that move through the stomach and small intestine between meals. They help clear leftover food, secretions, and some bacteria before the next meal.

Migration

Movement of cells, organisms, substances, or a body structure from one place to another. Normal examples include immune-cell movement and fetal development; abnormal migration can contribute to infection, cancer spread, or blood clots.

Migratory Thrombophlebitis

Recurrent or shifting venous thrombosis associated with an underlying malignancy; an alternate term for the thrombotic manifestation of Trousseau syndrome.

Milan System for Salivary Cytopathology

A six-level system for reporting results from a needle sample of a salivary-gland lump. Results range from an insufficient sample or noncancerous finding to a finding suspicious for or showing cancer. The system helps estimate cancer risk and guide further care.

Mild

Mild describes relatively low intensity, severity, or extent of a symptom, sign, disease, or abnormality. The meaning depends on the condition and the clinical scale used and does not by itself indicate that no treatment or evaluation is needed.

Mild Cognitive Impairment

A noticeable decline in memory or another thinking skill that is greater than expected for age but does not substantially prevent everyday activities. It may remain stable, improve, or progress to dementia depending on the cause.

Mildew Remover Poisoning

Poisoning from a mildew-removal product, often containing bleach, acids, or other corrosive chemicals. It can burn the skin, eyes, mouth, and digestive tract or release dangerous fumes that injure the lungs.

Mile

A mile is a unit of distance equal to 1,609.344 meters. It may be used in descriptions of walking or running distance, although scientific and clinical measurements generally use SI units.

Milia

Milia are tiny, firm, white or yellow bumps caused by small cysts containing keratin, a protein in the skin. They are common in newborns and may appear on the face in adults; they are harmless and usually go away on their own.

Miliaria

A sweat-retention skin disorder caused by obstruction of eccrine sweat ducts, often in hot or humid conditions. Trapped sweat produces small papules or vesicles that may be itchy or prickly.

Miliaria Crystallina

A harmless heat rash made of tiny clear blisters when sweat becomes trapped just beneath the skin's

surface. It can occur in hot, humid conditions or during fever and usually settles when the skin is cooled and kept dry.

Miliaria Profunda

A deeper form of heat rash caused by blocked sweat ducts in the lower layers of the skin. It often follows repeated episodes of miliaria rubra and causes firm, skin-colored bumps. The affected areas may sweat less, making it harder for the body to cool.

Miliaria Rubra

A common form of heat rash that causes itchy, prickly red bumps or small blisters when sweat ducts are blocked in the skin.

Miliary

Describing many tiny spots or lesions that resemble millet seeds. The term is often used for tuberculosis or another disease spread widely through an organ or the bloodstream.

Miliary TB

Tuberculosis that has spread through the bloodstream, producing many tiny areas of infection in the lungs and sometimes the liver, brain, bone marrow, or other organs. It can cause fever, weight loss, night sweats, cough, or organ-specific symptoms.

Miliary Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis that spreads through the bloodstream and forms many tiny areas of infection. It may affect the lungs, liver, brain, bone marrow, or other organs and can cause prolonged fever, weight loss, night sweats, cough, or organ-specific symptoms.

Milieu Therapy

Milieu therapy uses the structured social environment of a treatment setting as part of care, especially in some psychiatric and rehabilitation programs.

Milium

A small, firm, white or yellow bump filled with keratin, usually appearing on the face. It is harmless, does not spread by infection, and may disappear on its own or be removed safely by a clinician.

Milk-Alkali Syndrome

A condition caused by taking too much calcium and absorbable alkali, leading to high blood calcium, excessive blood alkalinity, and kidney problems. Severe cases can cause confusion, vomiting, dehydration, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Milk Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins in cow's milk, often beginning in infancy. It may cause hives, vomiting, wheezing, eczema, diarrhea, or anaphylaxis; it differs from lactose intolerance, which is difficulty digesting milk sugar.

Alternate Names:
Cow's Milk Allergy; Cow's Milk Protein Allergy; CMPA

Milker's Node

A localized nodular skin infection caused by parapoxvirus acquired from infected cattle, also called orf-like milker's nodule.

Milk Intolerance

Difficulty tolerating milk, often because of lactose malabsorption, causing bloating, cramps, gas, or diarrhea; it is not the same as milk-protein allergy.

Milkman Syndrome

Multiple small weak areas or incomplete breaks in bones, also called Looser zones. They can occur in severe osteomalacia or rickets and may cause bone pain, weakness, or fractures.

Alternate Names:
Looser-Milkman Syndrome; Pseudofracture Syndrome

Milk Of Magnesia

A liquid suspension of magnesium hydroxide used to neutralize stomach acid and relieve constipation. It draws water into the bowel and can cause diarrhea, especially when taken too often or in kidney disease.

Milky Urine

Urine with a cloudy or white appearance caused by chyle, pus, crystals, fat, or other substances; evaluation identifies the cause.

Millard-Gubler Syndrome

A ventral pontine stroke syndrome caused by an ischemic or hemorrhagic lesion in the lower pontine tegmentum, characterized by ipsilateral abducens nerve (CN VI) palsy, ipsilateral peripheral facial nerve (CN VII) palsy, and contralateral hemiparesis of the upper and lower extremities.

Alternate Names:
Ventral Pontine Syndrome; Facial Abducens Hemiplegia Syndrome

Miller Fisher Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Fisher Syndrome*.

Miller's Lung

Hypersensitivity pneumonitis caused by inhaling material associated with the granary weevil (wheat weevil, *Sitophilus granarius*), especially in people working with contaminated grain or flour.

Millicurie

A millicurie (mCi) is one-thousandth of a curie, equal to approximately 37 megabecquerels. It is used to express the activity of radioactive sources and some radiopharmaceutical doses.

Milliequivalent

A unit used to measure the amount and electrical combining power of charged substances, such as sodium, potassium, calcium, or chloride, in medicines and laboratory results.

Milligram

A metric unit of mass equal to one-thousandth of a gram. Its abbreviation is mg, and it is commonly used for medicine doses and small quantities of substances.

Milligram-Percent

An older concentration unit meaning milligrams of a substance in 100 milliliters of fluid. Its number is the same as milligrams per deciliter, written mg/dL, which is preferred in current medical reporting.

Milligray

A unit of absorbed ionizing-radiation dose equal to one-thousandth of a gray, or 0.001 joule per kilogram; its abbreviation is mGy.

Milliliter

A unit of volume equal to one-thousandth of a liter and one cubic centimeter. It is commonly used to measure liquid medicines, blood, urine, laboratory samples, and other small amounts of fluid.

Millimeter

A unit of length equal to one-thousandth of a meter.

Millimolar

A concentration unit equal to one thousandth of a mole per liter, written as mmol/L.

Millimole

A unit measuring the amount of a chemical substance equal to one-thousandth of a mole. Laboratory tests use millimoles to report substances such as glucose, sodium, potassium, and other electrolytes.

Million

A number equal to 1,000,000; laboratory counts may use it as a numerical multiplier.

Milliosmole

A milliosmole (mOsm) is one-thousandth of an osmole, a unit reflecting the number of osmotically active particles in a solution. Osmolality and osmolarity are commonly reported in mOsm/kg or mOsm/L.

Millipede Toxin

Irritating defensive chemicals released by some millipedes. Contact can cause burning, redness, blistering, or dark staining of skin and severe eye irritation; exposure is usually localized to the contact area.

Millisecond

A millisecond (ms) is one-thousandth of a second. It is used to measure brief physiologic events, reaction times, nerve conduction intervals, and timing of electrical or imaging signals.

Milliunit

A milliunit (mU) is one-thousandth of a unit of biologic or enzymatic activity. Because a unit is defined according to the substance or assay, the clinical meaning of a milliunit depends on the specific test or medication.

Millivolt

A unit of electrical voltage equal to one-thousandth of a volt. Small voltages are measured in millivolts in tests of the heart, brain, nerves, muscles, and other electrical activity in the body.

Milrinone

A medicine given by vein for short-term support in severe heart failure or after heart surgery. It helps the heart squeeze more strongly and widens blood vessels, but can lower blood pressure or trigger abnormal heart rhythms.

Milroy Disease

An inherited primary lymphedema caused most often by pathogenic variants affecting VEGFR3 signaling. It typically presents with chronic swelling of the lower limbs from birth or early infancy and may be associated with papillomatosis, hydrocele, or recurrent skin infection.

Milroy's Disease

An inherited form of primary lymphedema, usually present from birth or early life and caused commonly by lymphatic-development abnormalities.

Mimesis

Imitation or mimicry; in medicine, the term can refer to simulation of an organic disease by psychological symptoms or to one organic disease resembling another.

Mimicry

Resemblance of one organism, structure, or clinical pattern to another; in medicine, it may describe a disorder that imitates another disease.

Minamata Disease

A nervous-system disorder caused by poisoning with methylmercury, often after eating contaminated seafood. It can cause numbness, poor coordination, vision or hearing problems, muscle weakness, speech difficulty, and developmental harm in children.

Mind

The collection of mental processes and capacities involved in consciousness, thought, perception, memory, emotion, judgment, and behavior.

Mindful Eating

Paying attention to hunger and fullness, eating slowly, and noticing food's taste and texture. It may improve awareness of eating habits and help some people reduce distracted eating or overeating.

Mineral

An inorganic chemical element or ion required in the human diet to maintain physiological cellular homeostasis, structural integrity, and metabolic pathways. Categorized based on daily dietary requirements into: Macrominerals (required in amounts $> 100\,\text{mg/day}$, including calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, sodium, potassium, chloride, and sulfur), which function as structural components of bone matrix (hydroxyapatite) and the predominant electrolytes regulating fluid balance, osmotic pressure, and electrical transmembrane action potentials; and Trace minerals / Microminerals (required in amounts $< 100\,\text{mg/day}$, including iron, zinc, copper, manganese, iodine, selenium, fluoride, and molybdenum), which act primarily as essential catalytic cofactors for metalloenzymes (e.g., iron in hemoglobin and cytochromes, zinc in carbonic anhydrase and DNA zinc-finger transcription factors, iodine in thyroid hormones). Deficiencies, malabsorption, or excessive toxic accumulation of minerals cause severe metabolic and systemic pathologies.

Mineralocorticoid

A class of adrenal-cortex steroid hormones, chiefly aldosterone, that act mainly on the kidney's distal nephron. They increase sodium reabsorption and potassium and hydrogen-ion excretion; water follows retained sodium, helping regulate extracellular fluid volume, electrolyte balance, and systemic blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Mineralocorticoids

Mineralocorticoid Receptor

A protein inside cells that responds mainly to aldosterone, a hormone made by the adrenal glands. It helps the kidneys retain salt and water and remove potassium, thereby affecting blood pressure and body-fluid balance.

Mineral Oil

Mineral oil is a purified mixture of liquid hydrocarbons derived from petroleum. It is used in some topical products, cosmetics, and laxatives; aspiration of liquid mineral oil can cause lipoid pneumonia.

Mineral Oil Overdose

Swallowing a large amount of mineral oil is dangerous mainly because it can enter the lungs during vomiting or reflux and cause lipoid pneumonia.

Minerals

Plural form; see *Mineral*.

Mineral Spirits Poisoning

Poisoning from mineral spirits, petroleum-based solvents used in paints and cleaning products. Swallowing or inhalation may cause dizziness, drowsiness, chemical pneumonitis, or breathing failure, especially after liquid enters the lungs.

Miner's Asthma

Asthma caused or worsened by repeated inhalation of dust, fumes, or other substances during mining work. It can cause wheezing, cough, chest tightness, and breathlessness that improve after leaving the exposure.

Miner's Nystagmus

An older term for visual disturbance and nystagmus reported in underground miners, associated with poor lighting and occupational conditions.

Minimal Change Disease

A kidney disease, common in children, in which the kidney tissue looks nearly normal under a standard microscope but leaks large amounts of protein into the urine. It can cause swelling and often responds well to treatment.

Minimal-Change Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Minimal Change Disease*.

Minimally Invasive Aortic Valve Surgery

Aortic valve surgery performed through a smaller incision than a full median sternotomy, such as a minithoracotomy or partial sternotomy. Transcatheter aortic valve replacement (TAVR) is a separate procedure.

Alternate Names:
Minimally Invasive Aortic Valve Replacement; MIAVR

Minimally Invasive Esophagectomy

Removal of part or all of the esophagus using thoracoscopic, laparoscopic, or robotic techniques through smaller incisions than open surgery. It may reduce surgical trauma or recovery time in selected patients; risks and outcomes depend on the procedure and the person's condition.

Alternate Names:
MIE

Minimally Invasive Gastrointestinal Surgery

Gastrointestinal operations performed through small incisions or natural orifices using laparoscopic, robotic, or endoscopic techniques, often reducing recovery time while retaining procedure-specific risks.

Minimally Invasive Heart Bypass Surgery

Coronary artery bypass graft (CABG) surgery performed through a small thoracotomy incision be-

tween the ribs, frequently on a beating heart without cardiopulmonary bypass, avoiding a traditional median sternotomy.

Alternate Names:
MIDCAB; Minimally Invasive Direct Coronary Artery Bypass; Less Invasive CABG

Minimally Invasive Hip Replacement

Hip-replacement surgery performed through a smaller or muscle-sparing approach to reduce tissue disruption. It still replaces damaged joint surfaces and has risks such as infection, blood clots, dislocation, fracture, nerve injury, or implant loosening.

Minimally Invasive Mitral Valve Surgery

Mitral valve repair or replacement performed through smaller incisions, such as a right minithoracotomy, sometimes with video or robotic assistance, rather than a full median sternotomy. It may reduce surgical trauma or recovery time in selected patients; risks and outcomes depend on the procedure and the person's condition.

Alternate Names:
MIMVS; Mini-Thoracotomy Mitral Repair; Port-Access Mitral Surgery

Minimally Invasive Prostate Resection

Endoscopic or robotic transurethral procedures (such as holmium laser enucleation of the prostate [HoLEP], transurethral resection of the prostate [TURP], or robotic simple prostatectomy) performed to remove obstructive adenomatous tissue in benign prostatic hyperplasia.

Alternate Names:
Minimally Invasive BPH Resection

Minimally Invasive Spine Surgery

Spine surgery performed through small incisions using specialized instruments, often reducing muscle disruption and recovery time. It still carries risks such as nerve injury, infection, bleeding, and persistent symptoms.

Minimally Invasive Surgery

Surgery performed through small incisions or natural openings using specialized instruments, usually reducing tissue disruption and recovery time.

Minimal Residual Disease

A small number of cancer cells that remain after treatment and cannot be seen on routine examination or ordinary scans. Highly sensitive blood, bone-marrow, tissue, or molecular tests may detect them and estimate relapse risk.

Mini-Mental State Examination

A brief questionnaire that checks orientation, attention, memory, language, and simple thinking skills. The score can be affected by education, language, hearing, vision, culture, or delirium and cannot diagnose dementia by itself.

Minimization

A psychological or communication process of downplaying the importance or severity of symptoms, events, or problems.

Minimum Alveolar Concentration

A standard measure of how much inhaled anesthetic is needed to prevent movement in half of people during a specified surgical stimulus. It helps compare anesthetic strength and guide dosing during anesthesia.

Minimum Bactericidal Concentration

The lowest concentration of an antimicrobial that kills a defined proportion of the original bacterial inoculum, commonly demonstrated by subculture without growth. MBC is distinct from MIC and is not routinely required for every infection.

Minimum Effect Concentration

The lowest concentration of a drug in the blood or at its site of action that produces a defined measurable effect.

Minimum Inhibitory Concentration

The smallest amount of an antibiotic or other antimicrobial that stops a particular germ from visibly growing in a laboratory test. It helps guide treatment; significance varies with the infection and the

patient's condition.

Minimum Lethal Concentration

The lowest concentration of a substance associated with death in a defined test population or experimental setting.

Minimum Lethal Dose

The smallest dose of a substance reported to cause death under specified conditions; it varies by species, route, and individual.

Minipuberty

A normal, temporary rise in reproductive hormone activity during early infancy. Signals from the brain and pituitary gland stimulate the ovaries or testes to produce hormones. The timing and hormone pattern differ by sex; in boys, activity usually peaks in the first few months and declines by about six months.

Minisatellite Repeat

A minisatellite repeat is a tandemly repeated DNA sequence with repeat units commonly ranging from about 10 to 100 base pairs. Variation in repeat number can serve as a genetic marker and, in some loci, influence gene regulation or disease risk.

Mini-Stroke

A common but potentially misleading name for a transient ischemic attack; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

Mini-Stroke (TIA)

Alternate name; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

MINOCA

A heart attack occurring without a major blockage in the coronary arteries. It is an initial diagnosis; further tests are needed to find causes such as a small clot, artery spasm, artery-wall tear, or inflammation.

Minocycline

An antibiotic used for some bacterial infections and for inflammatory acne. It can cause nausea, dizziness, skin or tooth discoloration, sun sensitivity, and rarely liver or immune problems.

Minor

Smaller, lesser, or less significant than a related structure or condition; for example, the teres minor muscle is smaller than the teres major muscle.

Minority Health

The health status and healthcare experiences of populations affected by social, economic, cultural, or structural disadvantage. Differences in exposure, income, environment, discrimination, and access to care can contribute to health disparities.

Minor Response

A minor response is a limited improvement after treatment that does not meet the predefined criteria for a partial or complete response. The exact threshold depends on the disease, study protocol, and outcome being measured.

Minoxidil

A vasodilator used topically for pattern hair loss and orally in selected cases of resistant hypertension.

Minute Ventilation

The total amount of air breathed in one minute, calculated from breath size multiplied by breathing rate. It may rise with exercise or illness and fall with sedation, muscle weakness, airway disease, or poor breathing effort.

Miosis

Unusually small pupils or normal pupil narrowing in response to light. It may be caused by medicines or toxins, eye disease, or problems affecting nerves in the brain or eye.

Miosis Disorder

Abnormally small pupils or an abnormal pupillary constriction response, caused by medications, neurologic disease, ocular disease, or exposure to certain toxins.

Miotic

A medicine or substance that makes the pupil smaller. Miotics may be used in glaucoma or during some eye procedures and can affect vision in dim light.

Alternate Names:
Miotic Agent; Pupillary Constrictor

Miracidium

The ciliated larval stage of a trematode that hatches from an egg and infects a suitable snail host.

Mirage Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder, usually related to SAMD9 variants, that can cause growth restriction, adrenal insufficiency, recurrent infections, and distinctive developmental findings.

MIRD Schema

A method used to estimate how much radiation reaches organs and tissues after a radioactive medicine is given. It helps specialists plan treatment and assess safety for radiopharmaceutical procedures.

Mirizzi Syndrome

A gallstone stuck near the gallbladder outlet presses on a nearby bile duct and blocks the flow of bile. It can cause jaundice, abdominal pain, fever, or infection and may require an endoscopic or surgical procedure.

Mirror Therapy

A rehabilitation exercise in which a mirror makes movement of the stronger limb appear to come from the affected limb. It may help some people with phantom-limb pain or movement recovery after stroke.

Mirror-Writing

Writing in which letters or words are reversed as if seen in a mirror; it may occur transiently in childhood or with neurologic disease.

Mirtazapine

Mirtazapine is a noradrenergic and specific serotonergic antidepressant used for major depressive disorder. It commonly causes sedation and increased appetite or weight and can rarely cause neutropenia or other serious adverse effects.

Misalignment

Misalignment is abnormal positioning or orientation of two or more structures relative to their intended relationship. It may affect bones, joints, teeth, eyes, implants, or medical devices and can impair function or healing.

Miscarriage

Spontaneous loss of a pregnancy before fetal viability, commonly caused by chromosomal abnormalities but requiring clinical assessment.

Alternate Names:
Spontaneous Abortion; Early Pregnancy Loss

Misdiagnosis

Misdiagnosis is assignment of an incorrect diagnosis or failure to recognize the correct condition. It can lead to inappropriate treatment, delayed care, avoidable harm, or unnecessary testing and may result from atypical presentation, incomplete information, or system factors.

Mismatch Repair

A system that checks newly copied DNA and corrects small errors. When it fails, genetic changes can accumulate and increase the risk of cancers such as colorectal and womb cancer.

Mismatch Repair Deficiency

Loss of DNA mismatch-repair function that produces microsatellite instability and a high tumor mutational burden. Seen in Lynch syndrome and some sporadic colorectal, endometrial, and other cancers, and associated with responsiveness to immune checkpoint inhibitors.

MISME

Abbreviation; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 2*.

Misophonia

Misophonia is an intense emotional or physiologic reaction to specific repetitive sounds, such as chewing or tapping. It is not simple annoyance; behavioral strategies, sound management, and therapy can reduce impairment, while assessment considers anxiety, obsessive-compulsive symptoms, and sensory sensitivity.

Misoprostol

A synthetic prostaglandin analogue used for selected gynecologic and obstetric indications, including cervical ripening, labor induction, and medical management of some pregnancies. It can cause uterine contractions, bleeding, gastrointestinal effects, or uterine tachysystole; use depends on the clinical setting and gestational age.

Alternate Names:
Prostaglandin E1 Analogue

Missed Dose

A scheduled dose of a medicine that was not taken or administered. The appropriate response varies by drug and timing; doubling a dose can cause harm.

Missed Miscarriage

A nonviable intrauterine pregnancy that has not been expelled and may produce few or no symptoms of miscarriage. Diagnosis requires appropriate ultrasound or other clinical evaluation before management is selected.

Alternate Names:
Missed Abortion; Silent Miscarriage; Early Pregnancy Failure

Missed Period

Absence of an expected menstrual period. Pregnancy is common, but stress, weight change, endocrine disease, medications, perimenopause, and other conditions can also contribute.

Missense Mutation

A missense mutation is a DNA sequence change that substitutes one amino acid for another in a protein. Its effect may be harmful, beneficial, or neutral depending on the affected residue, protein function, and genetic context.

Missense Variant

A single-nucleotide substitution that changes one amino acid in a protein. Its clinical effect ranges from benign to pathogenic and must be assessed using molecular, functional, population, and clinical evidence.

Mistletoe Poisoning

Poisoning after eating mistletoe leaves or berries. It may cause nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, abdominal pain, dizziness, low blood pressure, slow or irregular heartbeat, seizures, or confusion; severe cases can be life-threatening.

Mitchell Disease

Alternate name for erythromelalgia, a disorder causing attacks of burning pain, warmth, and redness in the extremities; see *Erythromelalgia*.

Mite

A tiny, microscopic or near-microscopic invertebrate arthropod belonging to the subclass Acari (alongside ticks) within the class Arachnida. Characterized by an unsegmented cephalothorax and abdomen (idiosoma) and four pairs of walking legs in the adult stage. Clinically relevant mites include: (1) *Sarcoptes scabiei* var. *hominis*, an obligate human parasite that burrows within the stratum corneum of the epidermis, depositing eggs and feces that trigger severe type IV delayed-hypersensitivity pruritus (scabies); (2) *Demodex* species (*Demodex folliculorum* and *Demodex brevis*), commensal hair follicle and sebaceous gland mites associated with blepharitis, rosacea, and meibomian gland dysfunction; (3) House dust mites (*Dermatophagoides pteronyssinus* and *D. farinae*), whose excreted digestive enzymes (Der p 1 allergen) act as potent inhaled environmental allergens triggering bronchial asthma and allergic rhinitis; and (4) Chigger mites (larval Trombiculidae), which inject proteolytic digestive enzymes into human skin causing intensely pruritic papules and transmitting *Orientia tsutsugamushi* (scrub typhus) in the Asia-Pacific region.

Mites

Plural form; see *Mite*.

Mithramycin

An older antineoplastic antibiotic, also called plicamycin, whose use is limited by substantial toxicity.

Mitobronitol

Mitobronitol is an alkylating antineoplastic compound formerly investigated or used in selected hematologic malignancies. Its cytotoxic effects can damage DNA and cause myelosuppression and other treatment-related toxicities.

Mitochondria

Small structures inside cells that make much of the energy cells need. They also help control calcium, cell survival, and several metabolic processes; mitochondrial disorders can affect organs that need high energy, such as the brain, muscles, heart, and eyes.

Mitochondrial Cristae

Folds of the inner membrane of mitochondria, the energy-producing parts of cells. The folds provide space for the machinery that turns nutrients into usable cellular energy.

Mitochondrial Diabetes

Diabetes caused by a change in mitochondrial DNA, which is usually passed through the mother. It may occur with hearing loss, muscle problems, or other mitochondrial symptoms; insulin production is often reduced and genetic testing may confirm the cause.

Mitochondrial Disease

A group of genetic disorders caused by impaired mitochondrial energy production. Symptoms vary and may affect the brain, muscles, nerves, heart, eyes, or multiple organs; onset and severity can differ widely even within one family.

Mitochondrial DNA

Small circular DNA molecules located primarily in mitochondria that encode some components of oxidative phosphorylation and are inherited predominantly through the maternal line.

Mitochondrial DNA Depletion Syndromes

A group of inherited disorders in which affected tissues have abnormally low amounts of mitochondrial DNA. This reduces mitochondrial energy production; depending on the subtype, the brain, muscles, liver, or several organs may be affected, often beginning in infancy or childhood.

Alternate Names:
Mitochondrial DNA Depletion Syndrome; MDDS

Mitochondrial Fission

Mitochondrial fission is division of one mitochondrion into two or more mitochondria. It helps distribute mitochondria, remove damaged portions through mitophagy, and respond to cell-cycle or metabolic signals; excessive fission may contribute to disease.

Mitochondrial Fusion

Mitochondrial fusion is joining of mitochondria into a connected network. It permits exchange of mitochondrial contents and helps maintain bioenergetic function and genome integrity; fusion and fission are normally balanced dynamically.

Mitochondrial Inheritance

Inheritance of mitochondrial DNA, which is transmitted predominantly through the egg and therefore usually from the mother. Examples include Leber hereditary optic neuropathy and MELAS. Heteroplasmy means that mutant and normal mitochondrial DNA coexist in a cell.

Mitochondrial Matrix

The mitochondrial matrix is the protein-rich compartment enclosed by the inner mitochondrial membrane. It contains mitochondrial DNA, ribosomes, and enzymes for the citric-acid cycle, fatty-acid oxidation, and other metabolic processes.

Mitochondrial Membrane

The mitochondrial membrane system consists of an outer membrane and a highly folded inner mem-

brane separated by an intermembrane space. It controls transport and houses the respiratory chain and ATP-producing machinery.

Mitochondrial Myopathy

A muscle disorder caused by faulty mitochondria, the cell structures that make energy. It may cause weakness, exercise intolerance, drooping eyelids, hearing loss, seizures, or problems in other organs.

Mitochondrial Ribosome

A mitochondrial ribosome is a ribosome within mitochondria that translates proteins encoded by mitochondrial DNA. Its structure differs from cytosolic ribosomes and defects in mitochondrial translation can cause energy-production disorders.

Mitochondrial Swelling

Enlargement of mitochondria caused by disruption of ion and water balance, often indicating cellular injury, impaired oxidative phosphorylation, or permeability-transition changes.

Mitochondrion

A mitochondrion is a membrane-bound organelle that generates much of a cell's ATP through oxidative phosphorylation. It also participates in apoptosis, calcium handling, metabolism, and production or regulation of reactive oxygen species.

Mitogen

A mitogen is a substance that stimulates a cell, especially a lymphocyte, to enter the cell cycle and proliferate. Mitogens include growth factors, lectins, and other signals that activate proliferative pathways.

Mitolactol

Mitolactol is an alkylating antineoplastic compound formerly used or investigated in cancer treatment. It damages DNA and can cause cytotoxic effects such as myelosuppression and gastrointestinal toxicity.

Mitomycin

A potent antineoplastic antibiotic originally isolated from the soil bacterium *Streptomyces caespitosus*, predominantly represented clinically by Mitomycin C. It functions as a bioreductive alkylating agent: following intracellular enzymatic reduction (catalyzed by NADPH-cytochrome P450 reductase or NQO1), it transforms into an active bifunctional alkylating metabolite that forms covalent cross-links between complementary strands of DNA (specifically at guanine residues within 5′-CpG-3′ sequences). This induces irreversible DNA interstrand cross-linking, inhibiting DNA replication, arresting cells in the late G1 and S phases of the cell cycle, and triggering apoptosis, with preferential cytotoxicity toward hypoxic tumor cells. Utilized clinically as systemic chemotherapy for gastrointestinal adenocarcinomas (gastric, pancreatic, colorectal, anal squamous cell carcinoma in the Nigro protocol) and as local topical or intravesical instillation for non-muscle-invasive bladder cancer and in ophthalmologic glaucoma trabeculectomy to prevent postoperative scar formation. Major dose-limiting toxicities include cumulative myelosuppression (thrombocytopenia and leukopenia), interstitial pneumonitis, and hemolytic uremic syndrome (HUS / thrombotic microangiopathy).

Mitomycins

Plural form; see *Mitomycin*.

Mitophagy

The process by which a cell identifies and breaks down damaged or unnecessary mitochondria, the cell's energy-producing structures. This helps maintain healthy cells; abnormal mitophagy may contribute to some diseases.

Mitosis

Cell division that produces two genetically similar daughter cells with the same chromosome number as the parent cell.

Mitosporic Fungi

Fungi that reproduce by asexual spores; the term is mainly used for fungi whose sexual stage is unknown or not observed.

Mitotane

Mitotane is an adrenolytic drug used for selected adrenocortical carcinomas and to suppress excess adrenal steroid production. It can cause gastrointestinal and neurologic effects, adrenal insufficiency, and numerous drug interactions.

Mitotic Anaphase

Mitotic anaphase is the stage of mitosis in which sister chromatids separate and move toward opposite poles of the cell. Accurate spindle attachment and chromosome segregation are required for formation of genetically similar daughter cells.

Mitotic Figure

A cell seen under a microscope while it is dividing. The number of dividing cells in a tissue sample can help estimate how quickly a tumor or other tissue is growing.

Mitotic Metaphase

Mitotic metaphase is the stage of mitosis in which duplicated chromosomes align at the cell equator with sister kinetochores attached to opposite spindle poles. A checkpoint helps prevent premature chromosome separation.

Mitotic Prophase

Mitotic prophase is the early stage of mitosis in which chromatin condenses into visible chromosomes, the nucleolus disappears, and the mitotic spindle begins to form. In late prophase or prometaphase, the nuclear envelope breaks down.

Mitotic Recombination

Mitotic recombination is exchange or rearrangement of DNA between homologous chromosomes during or around mitotic cell division. It can repair DNA or generate loss of heterozygosity and is relevant to tumor evolution and genetic disease.

Mitotic Telophase

Mitotic telophase is the stage after chromosome separation when chromosomes reach opposite poles, decondense, and become enclosed in newly forming nuclear envelopes. Cytokinesis usually follows or overlaps with telophase.

Mitoxantrone

A chemotherapy and immunosuppressive medicine that interferes with DNA and is used for selected cancers and some forms of multiple sclerosis.

MitraClip

A transcatheter device used for mitral valve edge-to-edge repair. It joins part of the anterior and posterior leaflets to reduce leakage; clinicians consider it for selected people with significant mitral regurgitation based on symptoms, valve anatomy, surgical risk, and other factors.

Mitral

Relating to the heart's mitral valve, which lies between the left upper and lower chambers. The valve opens for blood flow forward and closes to prevent backward leakage during each heartbeat.

Mitral Annular Calcification

Chronic calcium and fibrous deposition in the ring supporting the mitral valve. It is more common with older age and chronic kidney disease and can restrict leaflet motion, causing or worsening mitral regurgitation or degenerative mitral stenosis; echocardiography and sometimes CT assess its extent and consequences.

Mitral Atresia

A serious heart defect present from birth in which the opening of the mitral valve is absent or completely closed. Blood cannot flow normally into the heart's main pumping chamber; treatment involves staged surgery or transplantation.

Mitral Facies

A distinctive physical appearance characterized by a purplish or violaceous malar flush and patchy cyanosis across the cheeks, bridge of the nose, and lips. It is caused by chronic pulmonary hypertension, systemic vasoconstriction, and reduced cardiac output in severe mitral stenosis.

Mitral Insufficiency

Failure of the mitral valve to close completely, allowing blood to leak back into the left atrium during systole.

Mitral Regurgitation

Leakage through the mitral valve during heart contraction (systole), allowing blood to flow backward from the left ventricle into the left atrium. It may result from abnormal valve leaflets or supporting structures, infection, or heart damage, and can cause breathlessness, fatigue, palpitations, or heart failure.

Mitral Stenosis

Narrowing of the mitral valve orifice that impedes diastolic blood flow from the left atrium into the left ventricle. Most commonly caused by rheumatic heart disease or severe degenerative calcification of the mitral annulus. Elevated left atrial pressures produce left atrial enlargement, atrial fibrillation, pulmonary venous congestion, and secondary pulmonary hypertension and right heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Mitral Valve Stenosis; MS

Mitral Stenosis Murmur

A low-pitched, mid-diastolic rumbling heart murmur heard best at the cardiac apex in the left lateral decubitus position, classically preceded by an opening snap and displaying presystolic accentuation in patients with normal sinus rhythm.

Mitral Valve

The two-flap valve between the heart's left upper and lower chambers. It opens to let blood pass forward and closes to prevent backward flow; it may become narrowed, leaky, infected, or weakened.

Mitral Valve Insufficiency

Leakage of the mitral valve that allows blood to flow backward into the left atrium when the heart contracts. It may cause breathlessness, fatigue, palpitations, swelling, or heart failure.

Mitral Valve Prolapse

Bulging of one or both mitral-valve leaflets backward into the left atrium when the heart contracts. It is often harmless but can cause mitral regurgitation, palpitations, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Alternate Names:
MVP; Barlow Syndrome; Click-Murmur Syndrome; Floppy Mitral Valve

Mitral Valve Regurgitation

Backward leakage of blood through the mitral valve when the left ventricle contracts, which can cause breathlessness, fatigue, atrial enlargement, or heart failure.

Alternate Names:
MR; Mitral Incompetence; Mitral Insufficiency

Mitral Valve Repair

Unhyphenated variant; see *Mitral-Valve Repair*.

Mitral-Valve Repair

A surgical or transcatheter procedure to restore mitral valve competence without replacement, typically for regurgitation from prolapse, chordal rupture, or ischemic dysfunction. Repair preserves native valve tissue, maintains left ventricular function, and avoids lifelong anticoagulation required by mechanical prostheses.

Mitral Valve Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Mitral Stenosis*.

Mitral Valvotomy

A procedure that opens a narrowed mitral valve so blood can move more easily from the upper to the lower left heart chamber. It may use a balloon catheter or surgery and is suitable only for selected valve anatomy.

Mitral Valvuloplasty

Mitral valvuloplasty is a procedure that widens a narrowed mitral valve, often with a balloon catheter or surgical repair.

Mitsuokella

Mitsuokella is a genus of anaerobic bacteria found mainly in the mouth and digestive tract; human infection is uncommon.

Mittelschmerz

Recurrent one-sided lower-abdominal or pelvic pain occurring around ovulation. It is usually brief or lasts up to a day or two; severe, persistent, or atypical pain can have other causes.

Mixed Anxiety and Depressive Disorder

A psychiatric condition characterized by coexisting symptoms of both anxiety and depression that cause clinically significant distress or impairment, without either symptom set meeting the full threshold for a standalone disorder.

Mixed Aortic Valve Disease

Narrowing of the aortic valve (aortic stenosis) and backward leakage through it (aortic regurgitation) occurring together. The two problems affect blood flow and the heart at the same time, so their combined severity is assessed rather than judging each in isolation.

Mixed Connective Tissue Disease

An autoimmune illness with features of lupus, scleroderma, and inflammatory muscle disease. It may cause color changes in fingers with cold, swollen hands, joint pain, muscle weakness, swallowing problems, or inflammation around organs.

Alternate Names:
MCTD; Sharp Syndrome

Mixed Connective Tissue Disease-Associated Arthritis

Joint pain or inflammation occurring with mixed connective tissue disease, an autoimmune condition with features of lupus, systemic sclerosis, and inflammatory muscle disease.

Mixed Connective Tissue Disease (MCTD)

Alternate name; see *Mixed Connective Tissue Disease*.

Mixed Hearing Loss

Hearing loss caused by both a problem carrying sound through the outer or middle ear and a problem in the inner ear or hearing nerve. The best treatment depends on the causes found.

Mixed Hepatic Porphyria

An acute hepatic porphyria in which inherited impairment of heme synthesis can cause episodic abdominal and neurologic symptoms and, in some people, photosensitive skin disease.

Mixed-Lineage Leukemia

A leukemia in which malignant cells show defining features of more than one blood-cell lineage, usually myeloid and lymphoid. The current term for this entity is mixed-phenotype acute leukemia (MPAL).

Alternate Names:
Mixed-Phenotype Acute Leukemia; MPAL

Mixed Mitral Valve Disease

Narrowing of the mitral valve (mitral stenosis) and backward leakage through it (mitral regurgitation) occurring together. The two problems affect blood flow and pressure in the heart at the same time, so their combined severity is assessed rather than judging each in isolation.

Mixed Oedema

Edema caused by more than one mechanism or affecting more than one tissue compartment; interpretation depends on clinical context.

Mixed Urinary Incontinence

Urine leakage caused by both a sudden strong urge to urinate and pressure from coughing, sneezing, laughing, or exercise. Treatment may include bladder training, pelvic-floor exercises, medicines, or procedures.

Miyoshi Myopathy

A rare inherited muscle disease that usually begins in adolescence or early adulthood with progressive

weakness of the calf muscles. People may have difficulty standing on tiptoe or climbing stairs; weakness later spreads to the thighs and hips. Blood tests often show high muscle-enzyme levels. Physical therapy helps maintain movement and function.

Alternate Names:
Miyoshi Distal Myopathy; Distal Dysferlinopathy

MME

Membrane metalloendopeptidase, also called neprilysin, CD10, neutral endopeptidase, or CALLA; it is a cell-surface enzyme and marker expressed in several tissues and in some acute lymphoblastic leukemias.

Mobile

Capable of moving or being moved; a mass or structure described as mobile is not fixed to adjacent tissue.

Mobile Genetic Elements

Genetic elements that can move within and between genomes. These include plasmids, transposons, and integrons. Mobile genetic elements can carry antibiotic resistance genes and virulence factors. They facilitate horizontal gene transfer and contribute to the rapid evolution of bacteria.

Mobile Health

The use of phones, tablets, wearable devices, or similar portable technology to support health care. Uses include reminders, remote monitoring, education, communication, symptom tracking, and some diagnostic tools; privacy, accuracy, accessibility, and clinical oversight remain important.

Alternate Names:
mHealth

Mobile Health Unit

A mobile health unit is a vehicle or transportable facility equipped to provide health services at changing locations. It may deliver screening, vaccination, primary care, diagnostic testing, emergency support, or outreach to underserved communities.

Mobility

The ability to move or be moved, including functional movement of a person or range of motion of a joint.

Mobilization

The process of restoring or encouraging movement, such as early patient activity, joint movement, or surgical release of tissue.

Mobiluncus

A genus of curved anaerobic bacteria associated with bacterial vaginosis and occasionally isolated from other clinical specimens.

Mobiluncus Curtisii

A curved bacterium that grows without oxygen and may be present with bacterial vaginosis. Its detection can support assessment, but symptoms, examination, and other test results are needed to interpret vaginal findings.

Mobiluncus Mulieris

A curved bacterium that grows without oxygen and may be associated with bacterial vaginosis. Finding it can support a diagnosis, but symptoms, examination, and other laboratory results are also important.

Mobitz Type I

A form of second-degree atrioventricular (AV) block characterized on electrocardiography by progressive PR interval prolongation in successive beats until a single P wave fails to conduct to the ventricles (dropped QRS), after which the cycle repeats (Wenckebach periodicity), typically localized within the AV node.

Alternate Names:
Wenckebach Block; Second-Degree AV Block Mobitz I

Mobitz Type I Block

A form of second-degree atrioventricular block characterized electrocardiographically by progressive lengthening of the PR interval in consecutive car-

diac cycles until an atrial P wave fails completely to conduct to the ventricles (dropped QRS complex). The cycle then resets with a shorter PR interval. Typically localized to physiological or pathological fatigue within the atrioventricular node, often benign and reversible.

Alternate Names:
Wenckebach Block; Mobitz I AV Block

Mobitz Type II

A high-grade form of second-degree atrioventricular (AV) block characterized on electrocardiography by intermittent, non-conducted P waves (dropped QRS complexes) occurring without prior PR interval prolongation, typically localized in the infranodal His-Purkinje system and carrying a high risk of progression to complete heart block.

Alternate Names:
Second-Degree AV Block Mobitz II; Infranodal AV Block

Mobitz Type II Block

A heart rhythm problem in which some signals from the upper chambers fail to reach the lower chambers without the warning lengthening of the PR interval. It can suddenly worsen into complete heart block; a pacemaker is often used when the cause is not reversible.

Alternate Names:
Mobitz II AV Block; Infranodal Second-Degree AV Block

Mobius Syndrome

A rare condition present from birth that affects certain facial and eye-moving nerves. It can cause facial weakness or paralysis, trouble closing the eyes, limited outward eye movement, and feeding or speech difficulties.

Modafinil

A prescription medicine that promotes wakefulness in narcolepsy, shift-work sleep disorder, and persistent sleepiness from obstructive sleep apnea when airway treatment is adequate. It can cause headache, anxiety, insomnia, serious rash, or dependence and is not a substitute for sleep or airway treatment.

Modality

A particular method used for treatment, diagnosis, imaging, or sensory stimulation. Examples include surgery, medicines, ultrasound, MRI, physiotherapy, and forms of counseling; the best modality depends on the health problem and the person's needs.

Mode

The most frequent value in a dataset or a particular manner or method of operation.

Model

A simplified representation used to describe, explain, predict, or study a biological or clinical process.

Moderate To Severe Disabilities

Moderate to severe disability describes substantial limitations in physical, cognitive, sensory, communication, or adaptive functioning that require ongoing support. Needs vary widely and may include medical care, rehabilitation, assistive technology, education, and assistance with daily activities.

Moderation

Moderation is reduction or control of the intensity, amount, or severity of a process, symptom, behavior, or treatment effect. In clinical research, a moderator is a factor that changes the strength or direction of an association.

Moderator

A factor that changes the strength or direction of a relationship or treatment effect; it may also mean a person who guides a discussion.

Modes Of Inheritance

Patterns by which genetic traits pass through families, including autosomal dominant, autosomal recessive, X-linked, mitochondrial, and other patterns.

Modified Biophysical Profile

A pregnancy assessment that combines a fetal heart-rate test with measurement of the amniotic-fluid volume. A nonreactive heart-rate result or low fluid level may suggest that further assessment or delivery

is needed, depending on gestational age and the clinical situation.

Alternate Names:
Modified BPP; NST with Amniotic Fluid Index

Modulator

A substance or factor that alters the activity of a biological pathway, receptor, gene, or physiological process.

Modus Operandi

The characteristic method by which a person performs an action; it is chiefly a forensic or legal term.

Modus Vivendi

A practical arrangement or way of living that allows people or groups with differences to coexist.

MODY

A group of monogenic diabetes forms, also called maturity-onset diabetes of the young, caused by pathogenic variants in a single gene affecting insulin secretion or glucose regulation. It often begins in adolescence or early adulthood and may appear across successive generations, but age at diagnosis and clinical features vary by subtype. It is distinct from type 1 and type 2 diabetes.

Moebius Syndrome

A congenital disorder characterized mainly by facial paralysis and inability to abduct the eyes, caused by developmental cranial-nerve abnormalities.

Moellerella

A rare group of bacteria that can occasionally cause urinary, bloodstream, or other infection, mainly in people who are seriously ill or have weakened defenses. Laboratory identification is needed to determine whether a specimen represents true infection.

Moellerella Wisconsensis

A rare type of bacterium that can occasionally cause urinary, bloodstream, wound, or other infections, especially in people with serious illness or weakened immunity. Laboratory testing identifies it and guides antibiotic choice.

Moeller's Glossitis

An older term for a smooth, painful, inflamed tongue associated especially with nutritional deficiency, including iron, folate, or vitamin B12 deficiency.

MOGAD

Abbreviation; see *MOG Antibody-Associated Disorder*.

MOG Antibody-Associated Disorder

A rare immune disorder in which antibodies target MOG, a protein on nerve coverings in the brain, optic nerves, and spinal cord. It can cause inflammation in these areas and problems with vision, movement, or balance.

Alternate Names:
MOGAD; MOG Antibody Disease; Myelin Oligodendrocyte Glycoprotein Antibody-Associated Disease

Mogibacterium

A genus of anaerobic bacteria found in the mouth and intestine and occasionally associated with dental or other infection.

Mohs Micrographic Surgery

Skin-cancer surgery in which the visible tumor and a thin layer of surrounding tissue are removed in stages. Each layer is mapped and examined under a microscope for cancer at its edges; additional tissue is removed only where cancer remains. The method preserves uninvolved tissue while checking margins during removal.

Mohs Surgery

Alternate name; see *Mohs Micrographic Surgery*.

Moisture

Water or other liquid present on a surface or in tissue; excessive moisture can cause maceration and skin breakdown.

Molar

Relating to a back tooth used for chewing, or to a chemical concentration measured in moles per liter.

Molar Pregnancy

An abnormal pregnancy in which placental tissue grows excessively instead of developing normally. In a complete mole no embryo forms; in a partial mole abnormal embryonic or fetal tissue may be present. It can cause bleeding, severe nausea, or unusually high pregnancy-hormone levels; follow-up tracks resolution and possible persistent disease.

Alternate Names:
Hydatid Mole; Hydatidiform Mole

Molasses

A viscous syrup produced during sugar refining; it is rich in sugar and may contain variable amounts of minerals.

Mold

A multicellular fungus that grows as branching filaments; molds can cause allergy, food spoilage, or opportunistic infection.

Mold Allergy

An allergic response to mold spores that may cause nasal, eye, skin, or lower-respiratory symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Fungal Hypersensitivity; Mold-Induced Rhinitis

Mold Exposure

Mold exposure can irritate the eyes, skin, and airways and may worsen asthma or allergic rhinitis; invasive infection is uncommon and mainly affects severely immunocompromised people. Reducing moisture and remediating contaminated areas are more useful than unproven detoxification.

Mole

A common, usually harmless skin growth made of pigment-producing cells. It may be flat or raised and brown, black, pink, or skin-colored. Changes in size, shape, color, or feel can sometimes signal skin cancer.

Molecular

Relating to molecules or processes occurring at the molecular level.

Molecular Chaperone

A molecular chaperone is a protein that assists other proteins with folding, assembly, transport, or refolding without becoming part of the final structure. Chaperones can also help prevent or resolve protein aggregation.

Molecular Diagnosis

Molecular diagnosis uses analysis of DNA, RNA, proteins, or other molecular markers to identify a disease, pathogen, inherited variant, tumor subtype, or treatment-relevant characteristic. Results require appropriate assay validation and clinical interpretation.

Molecular Dynamics

A computer method that predicts how atoms and molecules move and interact over time. Researchers use it to study protein shape, drug binding, chemical reactions, and other biological processes; its results depend on the model and assumptions used.

Molecular Imaging

Imaging that shows biological molecules, cell activity, or biochemical processes in the body, often using a targeted radioactive or fluorescent tracer. It can help characterize tumors, inflammation, infection, or organ function.

Molecular Pathology

The study of disease-related changes in genes, gene activity, or proteins within cells and tissues. It can help identify a disease, classify a tumor, estimate likely outcome, detect inherited risk, or select a treatment.

Molecular Pathology Of Colorectal Cancer

The assessment of molecular alterations that classify colorectal tumors and guide prognosis or therapy, including mismatch-repair deficiency or microsatellite instability, RAS mutations, BRAF mutation,

HER2 amplification, and selected gene fusions.

Molecular Probe

A molecular probe is a labeled or otherwise detectable molecule designed to bind a particular nucleic-acid sequence, protein, metabolite, or other target. Probes are used in imaging, assays, microscopy, and molecular diagnostics.

Molecular Response

A molecular response is a measurable change in a molecular marker, such as a pathogen load, oncogenic transcript, mutation burden, or biomarker, after disease progression or treatment. Its definition and clinical significance depend on the disease and assay.

Molecular Testing

Analysis of DNA, RNA, or other molecular features to identify variants, fusions, expression patterns, or infectious agents for diagnosis, prognosis, or treatment selection.

Molecular Weight

The mass of one molecule, usually expressed in atomic mass units; for a substance used in chemistry, its numerical value corresponds to molar mass in grams per mole. It helps calculate concentrations and doses.

Molecule

A group of chemically bonded atoms forming the smallest unit of a substance that retains its chemical properties.

Moles

Plural form; see *Mole*.

Molimina

The symptoms and physical changes that occur before menstruation, including breast tenderness, bloating, or mood changes.

Mollusc

A soft-bodied invertebrate; the term is also used in names of mollusc-borne or mollusc-associated parasitic diseases.

Mollusca

The animal group containing snails, slugs, clams, and related species. Some mollusks can cause illness through venom, contaminated food, or parasites they carry; medical risk depends on the species and exposure.

Molluscipoxvirus

A group of poxviruses that includes the virus causing molluscum contagiosum. Infection produces small, firm, usually painless skin bumps with a central dimple and spreads through close skin contact or shared items.

Molluscum Contagiosum

A benign skin infection caused by molluscum contagiosum virus, a poxvirus. It produces smooth, firm, pearly or skin-colored dome-shaped papules with central dimples, often in clusters. It spreads through direct contact or contaminated objects and may be extensive or persistent in people with weakened immunity.

Molten Metal Fumes

Fumes produced during welding, smelting, or casting that can cause metal-fume fever, airway irritation, or metal toxicity.

Molteno Implant

A small drainage device placed during glaucoma surgery to lower pressure inside the eye. A tube carries excess fluid to a plate under the surface tissue of the eye, where it can drain. It may be used when other treatments are unlikely to work or have failed.

Alternate Names:
Molteno Glaucoma Drainage Device; Molteno Aqueous Shunt; Molteno Seton

Molybdenum

An essential trace element required in small amounts for enzymes; excessive exposure can affect copper balance.

Molybdenum-99

A radioactive form of molybdenum that changes into technetium-99m. It is used in generator systems to produce technetium-99m, a radioactive tracer used for many medical scans.

Molybdenum Cofactor Deficiency

An inherited disorder in which cells cannot make or use the molybdenum cofactor required by enzymes such as sulfite oxidase and xanthine dehydrogenase. Severe neonatal disease may cause feeding difficulty, seizures, abnormal muscle tone, encephalopathy, and progressive brain injury.

Molybdosis

Illness caused by excessive molybdenum exposure, which may disturb copper metabolism and cause systemic effects.

Mometasone

Mometasone is a potent synthetic glucocorticoid used topically or by inhalation for inflammatory skin or airway disease. It reduces local inflammation but may cause skin atrophy, oral candidiasis, adrenal effects, or other corticosteroid adverse effects.

Mometasone Furoate

Mometasone furoate is the furoate ester of the corticosteroid mometasone. Depending on formulation, it is used for inflammatory skin disease, allergic rhinitis, or asthma; local and systemic corticosteroid precautions apply.

Momordica

A genus of plants including bitter melon; preparations may affect blood glucose and can interact with medicines.

Monascus

Monascus is a genus of fungi used in some fermented foods; some species produce pigments, while contamination can produce harmful mycotoxins.

Monckeberg Medial Calcific Sclerosis

A benign, non-inflammatory form of arteriosclerosis characterized by dystrophic ring-like calcification localized within the tunica media of medium and small muscular arteries without luminal obstruction or intimal ulceration, producing palpable 'lead-pipe' rigidity of peripheral vessels.

Alternate Names:
Mönckeberg Arteriosclerosis; Medial Calcific Sclerosis

Mondor Disease

A benign, self-limited superficial thrombophlebitis affecting the subcutaneous veins of the anterior chest wall and breast (lateral thoracic, thoracoepigastric, or superior epigastric veins), presenting as a palpable, painful, cord-like indurated subcutaneous band under tension.

Mondor'S Disease

Superficial thrombophlebitis of the anterior chest wall veins, typically the lateral thoracic, thoracoepigastric, or superior epigastric veins. Presents as a tender, cord-like subcutaneous structure with skin retraction. Usually self-limited; associated with breast surgery, trauma, or hypercoagulable states.

Mongolian Spot

An older term for congenital dermal melanocytosis, a flat blue-gray patch caused by pigment-producing cells in the deeper skin, usually present at birth. It is benign and often fades during childhood; documenting it can help distinguish it from bruising.

Monilethrix

Monilethrix is an inherited hair-shaft disorder in which hair has regularly spaced narrow segments and breaks easily, producing a beaded appearance. It commonly causes short, brittle scalp hair and may involve follicles elsewhere.

Monitored Anesthesia Care

Anesthesia care in which a trained professional gives medicines for comfort or pain relief and continuously watches breathing, heart rate, blood pressure, and oxygen. The level of sedation can be adjusted and emergency support is available.

Monitoring Device

A monitoring device measures and displays or records a physiologic variable, such as heart rhythm, oxygen saturation, blood pressure, glucose, temperature, or respiratory rate. Accuracy, calibration, and clinical context determine how results should be interpreted.

Monitoring Test

A test repeated over time to follow a disease, treatment response, medicine safety, or a possible complication. The result is interpreted with symptoms and earlier measurements.

Monkeypox

Former name; see *Mpox*.

Monkeypox (Mpox)

Alternate name; see *Mpox*.

Mono

Alternate name; see *Infectious Mononucleosis*.

Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitor (MAOI) Toxicity

Poisoning or interaction involving an MAOI that may cause severe hypertension, tachycardia, agitation, hyperthermia, seizures, or serotonin syndrome with clonus and hyperreflexia. Stop serotonergic or sympathomimetic drugs, provide benzodiazepines and supportive care, and manage rapidly changing blood pressure and temperature in an intensive setting.

Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitors

A class of medications that work by blocking monoamine oxidase, an enzyme responsible for breaking down chemical messengers in the brain such as serotonin, dopamine, and norepinephrine. By allowing these neurotransmitters to remain active longer, they help regulate mood in conditions such as depression. Because the enzyme also breaks down tyramine in the digestive system, taking these medications requires strict dietary restrictions to prevent dangerous spikes in blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
MAOIs; MAO Inhibitors

Monoarticular Joint Pain

Pain affecting one joint, caused by trauma, infection, crystal arthritis, osteoarthritis, or inflammatory arthritis. Acute pain with swelling, warmth, fever, or inability to bear weight can occur with septic arthritis.

Monobactams

A class of antibiotics used mainly for certain infections caused by oxygen-using Gram-negative bacteria. Aztreonam is the main example; laboratory testing and allergy history help guide its use.

Monoblast

An early bone marrow cell that develops into a monocyte, a type of infection-fighting white blood cell.

Monoblast Count

A monoblast count is the number or proportion of monoblasts, immature precursors of monocytes, in a blood or bone-marrow sample. Increased blasts may support evaluation for acute myeloid leukemia or another marrow disorder and require expert morphologic or immunophenotypic interpretation.

Monochorionic Twin Pregnancy

A twin pregnancy in which identical twins share a single placenta. Because the babies share placental blood vessels, the pregnancy carries unique risks such as twin-to-twin transfusion syndrome and unequal growth, requiring frequent ultrasound monitoring throughout pregnancy. Twins may have separate inner fluid sacs (diamniotic) or rarely share a single sac (monoamniotic).

Alternate Names:
Monochorionic Twins

Monoclonal

Made by, or arising from, one original cell and therefore very similar to that cell. A monoclonal antibody is designed to recognize one specific target in the body or in a laboratory test.

Monoclonal Antibodies

Antibodies produced from a single B-cell clone and directed against one antigenic target; they are used in diagnosis and treatment.

Monoclonal Antibody

A laboratory-made immune protein designed to recognize one specific target. Monoclonal antibodies are used in tests and treatments for cancer, inflammatory disease, infection, and other conditions.

Monoclonal Gammopathy Of Undetermined Significance

A benign, non-cancerous condition in which abnormal plasma cells in the bone marrow produce an elevated amount of a specific antibody protein, known as an M-protein or monoclonal protein. It generally causes no symptoms and does not damage bones, kidneys, or blood counts, but it requires regular medical monitoring because it carries a small annual risk of progressing into multiple myeloma or another blood disorder.

Alternate Names:
MGUS; Monoclonal Paraproteinemia

Monoclonal Gammopathy of Undetermined Significance (MGUS)

Alternate name; see *Monoclonal Gammopathy Of Undetermined Significance*.

Monocrotophos

Monocrotophos is a highly toxic organophosphorus insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase. Exposure can cause acute cholinergic poisoning with secretions, bronchospasm, vomiting, bradycardia, weakness, seizures, and respiratory failure.

Monocular

Involving or affecting one eye, or occurring with vision from one eye. Monocular vision can reduce depth perception and may result from eye disease, injury, or loss of vision in the other eye.

Monocyte

The largest type of circulating mononuclear leukocyte in peripheral blood, measuring 12–20 μm in diameter, constituting approximately 2–8% of circulating white blood cells. Originating from myeloid progenitor cells in the bone marrow under the influence of colony-stimulating factor 1 (M-CSF), monocytes are characterized morphologically by an indented, kidney- or horseshoe-shaped nucleus, delicate lace-like chromatin, and abundant grayish-blue cytoplasm containing fine azurophilic granules (lysosomes with peroxidase, acid phosphatase, and lysozyme). Monocytes circulate in the vascular system for 1 to 3 days before extravasating through capillary endothelial walls into tissues throughout the body, where they differentiate into specialized tissue-resident macrophages (e.g., alveolar macrophages in lungs, Kupffer cells in liver, osteoclasts in bone, microglia in central nervous system) or inflammatory dendritic cells. In the innate and adaptive immune response, monocytes function as avid phagocytes, professional antigen-presenting cells expressing MHC class II molecules, and major producers of pro-inflammatory cytokines (TNF-α, IL-1, IL-6, IL-12). Monocytosis ($> 1.0 \times 10^9$/L) occurs in chronic bacterial infections (tuberculosis, subacute bacterial endocarditis), autoimmune diseases, and chronic myelomonocytic leukemia (CMML).

Monocytes

Plural form; see *Monocyte*.

Monocytopenia

An abnormally low number of monocytes, a type of white blood cell, in the blood. It may occur with bone-marrow disorders, medicines, infections, or severe illness and is interpreted with the full blood count.

Monocytosis

An increased absolute number of circulating monocytes. It may be reactive to infection or inflammation or associated with a hematologic neoplasm; persistent or marked elevations can indicate an underlying disorder.

Monogenic

Describing a condition or trait caused mainly by

a change in one gene. The change may be inherited from a parent or arise for the first time in the affected person.

Monogenic Obesity

Severe or early-onset obesity caused mainly by a disease-causing change in one gene. The affected gene may alter appetite or the body's control of energy use.

Monograph

A monograph is a detailed, authoritative document devoted to one subject. In health care it may describe a drug's identity, quality, pharmacology, indications, dosing, safety, or regulatory standards.

Mono (Infectious Mononucleosis)

Alternate name; see *Infectious Mononucleosis*.

Monoiodotyrosine

Monoiodotyrosine is an iodinated tyrosine residue formed during thyroid-hormone synthesis. Coupling of iodinated tyrosine residues within thyroglobulin contributes to production of thyroxine and triiodothyronine.

Monokines

Monokines are cytokines produced chiefly by monocytes and macrophages, including mediators such as tumor necrosis factor and interleukin-1. They regulate inflammation, immune responses, fever, and communication among cells.

Monomer

A monomer is a relatively small molecule that can chemically bond with other monomers to form a polymer. Biological examples include amino acids and nucleotides; some industrial monomers can irritate tissues or be toxic.

Monomethylhydrazine

Monomethylhydrazine is a volatile, corrosive, highly toxic chemical used as a rocket propellant. Exposure can injure the eyes, skin, lungs, liver, and nervous system and may cause seizures or systemic poisoning.

Monomodal Visual Amnesia

A rare visual-memory disorder in which a person has marked difficulty recognizing or recalling visual information while other memory modalities may be relatively preserved; neurologic evaluation is needed to identify the cause.

Mononegavirales

An order of viruses with nonsegmented, negative-sense RNA genomes, including rabies, measles, Ebola, and respiratory syncytial viruses.

Mononeuritis Multiplex

A painful, asymmetrical, asynchronous sensory and motor peripheral neuropathy affecting at least two separate, non-contiguous named peripheral nerves, classically provoked by systemic necrotizing vasculitides (such as polyarteritis nodosa, microscopic polyangiitis, or cryoglobulinemia).

Alternate Names:
Multifocal Neuropathy

Mononeuropathy

Mononeuropathy is dysfunction or injury of a single peripheral nerve. Common causes include compression, trauma, ischemia, inflammation, and metabolic disease; symptoms follow the nerve's distribution and may include pain, numbness, weakness, or autonomic changes.

Mononuclear Leukocyte

A white blood cell with one main, unsegmented nucleus. Monocytes and lymphocytes are examples; they help remove damaged material, recognize germs, and coordinate immune responses.

Mononucleosis

Common shortened term; see *Infectious Mononucleosis*.

Mononucleosis Spot Test

A rapid blood test detecting heterophile antibodies associated with infectious mononucleosis; it may

be negative early in illness or in young children, so other testing may be needed.

Monoplegia

Complete paralysis of one arm or one leg. It can result from a stroke, brain or spinal-cord disease, or severe damage to a nerve. The cause is found through a neurological examination and, when needed, brain or spine imaging and nerve tests.

Monopodium

A single foot or one-sided foot structure; the term is uncommon and may be used descriptively in developmental anatomy.

Monorchidism

The presence of only one testis, either because the other failed to develop, descended, or was removed.

Monosaccharide

The simplest form of sugar, which cannot be split into a smaller carbohydrate. Glucose and fructose are examples; cells use these sugars mainly for energy.

Monosodium Glutamate

MSG, the sodium salt of glutamic acid, used as a flavor enhancer because it contributes umami taste; it occurs naturally in foods such as tomatoes and aged cheese.

Monosodium Urate

Needle-shaped crystals formed from urate that deposit in joints and other tissues and cause gout. Under polarized light microscopy, they are strongly negatively birefringent.

Alternate Names:
Monosodium Urate Crystals; MSU Crystals; Urate Crystals

Monosomy

A genetic condition in which a cell has one copy of a chromosome instead of the usual two. Effects depend on the chromosome and whether all cells or only some cells are affected.

Monospot Test

A rapid blood test that detects heterophile antibodies associated with infectious mononucleosis. It may be negative early in illness or in young children and does not directly detect Epstein-Barr virus; specific antibody testing may be needed.

Alternate Names:
Heterophile Antibody Test; Paul-Bunnell Test

Monotest

A rapid blood test that looks for heterophile antibodies produced during some cases of infectious mononucleosis. A negative result does not always exclude infection, especially early in illness or in young children.

Monounsaturated Fat

A dietary fatty acid characterized chemically by an acyl hydrocarbon chain containing exactly one carbon-carbon double bond with all remaining carbon atoms single-bonded (e.g., oleic acid [18 : 1 cis-9], the primary fatty acid in olive oil, canola oil, avocados, and nuts). The single double bond, typically in the *cis* geometric configuration, introduces a structural kink that lowers the melting point, making monounsaturated fatty acids (MUFAs) liquid at room temperature. In cardiovascular metabolism, replacing saturated fatty acids and refined carbohydrates with dietary monounsaturated fats lowers circulating low-density lipoprotein cholesterol (LDL-C) without reducing high-density lipoprotein cholesterol (HDL-C), reduces susceptibility of LDL particles to oxidative modification, improves endothelial function, and enhances insulin sensitivity, representing a cornerstone cardioprotective element of the Mediterranean dietary pattern.

Monounsaturated Fats

Plural form; see *Monounsaturated Fat*.

Monozygotic Twin

A monozygotic twin develops when one fertilized egg divides into two embryos. The twins share nearly identical nuclear genomes but can differ through developmental, epigenetic, mitochondrial, and environmental factors.

Mons Veneris

The rounded fatty prominence over the pubic bone in front of the external female genitalia.

Monteggia Fracture

A traumatic fracture of the proximal third of the ulnar shaft accompanied by dislocation or subluxation of the radial head at the proximal radioulnar joint (PRUJ), classified into four types by Bado.

Alternate Names:
Monteggia Fracture-Dislocation; Proximal Ulnar Fracture with Radial Dislocation

Monteggia Fracture-Dislocation

A traumatic forearm injury consisting of a fracture of the proximal third of the ulna associated with anterior, posterior, or lateral dislocation of the radial head at the proximal radioulnar joint.

Montelukast

Montelukast is a leukotriene CysLT1-receptor antagonist used for asthma prevention and allergic rhinitis; it is not a rescue bronchodilator, and neuropsychiatric adverse effects require attention.

Montelukast Sodium

Montelukast sodium is the sodium salt of montelukast, a leukotriene-receptor antagonist used for asthma prevention and allergic rhinitis. It is not a rescue bronchodilator and carries an important warning for possible neuropsychiatric adverse effects.

Montevideo Units

A measurement of the strength of uterine contractions over 10 minutes during labor. It is calculated from pressure readings obtained by a catheter inside the uterus and helps clinicians assess whether contractions are strong enough to support labor progress.

Montgomery Tubercles

Small oil-producing glands in the darker skin around the nipple. They often become more noticeable during pregnancy and breastfeeding and release oil that helps protect and lubricate the nipple; they are usually normal.

Montreal Cognitive Assessment

A brief screening test of memory, attention, language, problem-solving, visual-spatial skills, and orientation. It can identify possible thinking problems but does not by itself diagnose dementia; education, language, sensory impairment, and acute illness affect the score.

Mood

A lasting emotional state experienced by a person and noticed by others. Mood may be described as depressed, anxious, irritable, elevated, or stable and can change with illness, medicines, stress, or life events.

Mood Disorder

A broad category of psychiatric illnesses characterized predominantly by severe, pervasive, and persistent disturbances in an individual's internal emotional state (mood) and affective expression that are out of proportion to external circumstances, causing substantial functional disability and subjective distress. Broadly categorized into two primary divisions: (1) Depressive Disorders (unipolar depression, encompassing major depressive disorder, persistent depressive disorder [dysthymia], and premenstrual dysphoric disorder), defined by persistent sadness, emptiness, irritability, anhedonia, fatigue, neurovegetative disturbances in sleep and appetite, feelings of worthlessness, and suicidal ideation; and (2) Bipolar and Related Disorders (bipolar I disorder, defined by at least one manic episode; bipolar II disorder, defined by hypomanic episodes and major depressive episodes; and cyclothymic disorder), characterized by pathological mood swings between depressive episodes and elevated, expansive, or irritable manic or hypomanic states with decreased need for sleep, pressured speech, racing thoughts, and impulsivity. Management utilizes evidence-based psychotherapy (cognitive behavioral therapy), mood stabilizers (lithium, valproate), second-generation antipsychotics, antidepressants (SSRIs, SNRIs), and neurostimulation therapies (electroconvulsive therapy, transcranial magnetic stimulation).

Mood Disorders

Plural form; see *Mood Disorder*.

Mood Stabilizers

Medicines used mainly to treat or prevent episodes of mania and depression in bipolar disorder. Examples include lithium, valproate, carbamazepine, and lamotrigine; each has different benefits, interactions, monitoring needs, and risks during pregnancy.

Mood Swing

A mood swing is a noticeable change in emotional state or affect over time. Occasional changes can be normal, while frequent, severe, or impairing swings may occur with mood disorders, substance use, medical illness, medications, or sleep disruption.

Morale

Morale is the confidence, motivation, and sense of shared purpose within a person or group. It can affect teamwork and occupational well-being but is not itself a specific medical diagnosis.

Moraxella

Moraxella is a genus of bacteria that can colonize the respiratory tract and cause ear, sinus, eye, or respiratory infections.

Moraxella Atlantae

A rare Moraxella species; the significance of its recovery from a clinical sample varies with the site and other evidence of infection.

Moraxellaceae

A family of bacteria that includes Moraxella and related organisms. Some normally live on the skin or in the airways, while others can cause ear, sinus, lung, wound, or bloodstream infections.

Moraxella Lincolnii

Moraxella lincolnii is a rare respiratory-tract bacterium; clinical importance depends on the specimen and evidence of infection.

Moraxella Oblonga

Moraxella oblonga is a rare Moraxella species found in respiratory or oral specimens; significance depends on clinical evidence of infection.

Moraxella Osloensis

An uncommon bacterium that can occasionally cause bloodstream, respiratory, wound, or other opportunistic infections, usually in people with serious illness or weakened immunity.

Morbidity

Illness or disability in a person or group of people. It can also mean how many people have a disease or how much illness or disability a disease causes.

Morbilli

The medical or Latin name for measles, an acute contagious viral infection with fever and a characteristic rash.

Morbilli Form

Resembling measles in appearance, especially a widespread rash made of flat and slightly raised spots. This description does not prove that a person has measles because medicines, infections, and other illnesses can cause similar rashes.

Morbillivirus

A genus of paramyxoviruses that includes measles virus and related animal viruses causing fever, respiratory illness, rash, or neurologic disease.

Morbus

A Latin word meaning disease. It appears in some older or formal disease names, but the word itself does not describe the cause, symptoms, or treatment of the condition.

Morcellation

The division of tissue into smaller fragments, often during minimally invasive surgery; it can spread an unrecognized cancer.

Mordant

A substance that helps fix a dye to tissue or a material, used in some histological staining methods.

Morgagni Hernia

A congenital diaphragmatic hernia occurring through the anterior retrosternal foramen of Morgagni, resulting from incomplete fusion of parts of the diaphragm. Abdominal contents may move into the chest and cause respiratory or gastrointestinal symptoms.

Morgagni-Turner-Albright Syndrome

Historical alternate name; see *Turner Syndrome*.

Morganella

Morganella is a genus of gram-negative bacteria that can cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, and other opportunistic infections.

Morganella Morganii

A gram-negative bacterium that can cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or postoperative infections, especially in hospitalized or medically vulnerable people. Antibiotic susceptibility varies, and resistance is common.

Morgellons Disease

A controversial condition involving distressing skin sensations and the belief that fibers or materials emerge from the skin. Symptoms are real to the person; possible dermatologic, neurologic, psychiatric, toxic, and infectious causes are described without establishing a specific mechanism.

Moribund

Extremely ill and at high risk of imminent death. The term describes a person's condition, but does not by itself determine whether treatment can help or what care is appropriate.

Morning Sickness

Nausea, with or without vomiting, during pregnancy. It often begins early and improves by the middle of pregnancy, but severe or persistent vomiting can cause dehydration, weight loss, and nutrient problems and may require fluids or other treatment.

Moro Reflex

A normal newborn startle response that causes the baby to spread out the arms, open the hands, and then draw the arms inward. It usually fades by about 3 to 6 months; an absent or unequal response may indicate a nerve or developmental problem.

Morphea

A localized sclerosing skin disorder that produces areas of thickened, hardened, or discolored skin and differs from systemic sclerosis by usually lacking internal-organ involvement.

Morpheus

The Greek and Roman mythological god of dreams; the name is the source of *morphine*, an opioid named for its association with sleep and dreams.

Morphinans

Morphinans are a group of chemical compounds with a fused-ring structure related to morphine. The class includes opioid analgesics and other compounds with varying receptor activity, potency, and clinical effects.

Morphine

Morphine is a potent opioid analgesic used for selected moderate-to-severe pain and palliative-care indications. It activates opioid receptors and can cause respiratory depression, sedation, constipation, nausea, tolerance, dependence, and overdose.

Morphine Overdose

Taking too much morphine can cause extreme sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or stopped breathing, low blood pressure, coma, and death. Naloxone can sometimes reverse opioid-related breathing suppression.

Morphine Sulfate

Morphine sulfate is a salt formulation of the opioid analgesic morphine. It is available in immediate-

and extended-release preparations for selected pain indications and carries risks of respiratory depression, misuse, dependence, and fatal overdose.

Morphogenesis

The biological process by which cells and tissues change shape, move, and organize to form organs and body structures during development or tissue repair.

Morphologic Response

A morphologic response is a treatment-related change in the visible or microscopic structure of a lesion, tumor, tissue, or cell population. It may include shrinkage, necrosis, differentiation, or altered cellular features and is interpreted using disease-specific criteria.

Morphology

The study or description of the form, shape, and structural features of organisms, organs, tissues, cells, or other biological structures.

Morquio Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which complex sugars build up and interfere mainly with bone and cartilage growth. It can cause short stature, an unusually shaped chest and spine, loose joints, cloudy corneas, and pressure on the spinal cord in the neck. Intelligence is usually unaffected. Treatment may include enzyme replacement, surgery, and careful monitoring of breathing and the spine.

Alternate Names:
Mucopolysaccharidosis Type Iv; MPS IV

Mortality

Death, or the number of deaths in a particular group during a stated period. A mortality measure may describe all causes of death or deaths from a specific disease and population.

Mortality Rate

The number of deaths in a specified population and time period, often reported for a particular disease or cause. It helps compare the impact of illness between groups when the populations are defined appropriately.

Morton Neuroma

Thickening and irritation of a nerve in the ball of the foot, usually between the third and fourth toes. It can cause burning pain, numbness, or the feeling of a pebble under the foot, often worsened by tight shoes or walking.

Alternate Names:
Interdigital Neuroma; Morton's Metatarsalgia; Plantar Interdigital Neuroma

Morton's Metatarsalgia

Pain in the forefoot beneath the metatarsal heads, caused by pressure or irritation and distinct from Morton neuroma.

Morton's Neuroma

Thickening and irritation of tissue around a nerve, usually between the third and fourth toes. It causes burning forefoot pain or a feeling of a pebble in the shoe and may improve with wider footwear.

Morton's Toe

A foot shape in which the second toe is longer than the big toe, often because the first metatarsal is relatively short. It is usually a normal variation but may contribute to pressure or forefoot pain.

Morula

A morula is an early embryo consisting of a compact ball of blastomeres formed after several cleavage divisions. It develops into a blastocyst before implantation in the uterine lining.

Morvan Disease – Syringomyelia

Historical or imprecise index label combining Morvan syndrome and syringomyelia, which are distinct neurologic disorders; see *Morvan's Disease* and *Syringomyelia*.

Morvan's Disease

A rare autoimmune neurologic syndrome with severe insomnia, hallucinations, confusion, pain, and peripheral nerve hyperexcitability.

Mosaic

Describing a person or tissue composed of two or more genetically different cell populations derived from one zygote, often because of a post-zygotic mutation or chromosomal event; mosaicism can alter the severity and distribution of a genetic disorder.

Mosaicism

The presence of groups of cells in one person that have different genetic material, even though all the cells came from the same fertilized egg. It may or may not cause disease, and its effects depend on which cells are affected.

Mosquito

A small blood-feeding insect whose bites may transmit malaria, dengue, West Nile virus, and other infections.

Mosquito-Borne

Spread by mosquitoes, usually describing an infection or parasite carried from one host to another by a mosquito bite. Examples include malaria, dengue, West Nile virus, yellow fever, and some forms of encephalitis.

Mosquito Clamp

A small hemostatic clamp used to compress small blood vessels.

Motilin

A hormone made mainly in the small intestine that helps trigger waves of movement through the stomach and small intestine, especially between meals. Its activity contributes to the pattern that clears leftover food and secretions from the upper digestive tract.

Motility

The ability of an organ to move its contents or itself. Intestinal motility moves food and waste forward, while abnormal motility can cause pain, constipation, diarrhea, vomiting, or swallowing problems.

Motion Analysis

A detailed study of how a person moves during walking, reaching, or other activities. Clinicians use measurements and video to find movement problems, understand their causes, plan treatment, and track improvement.

Motion Artifact

Image distortion or blurring caused by movement of the patient, organs, or equipment during image acquisition.

Motion Correction

Processing or acquisition methods that reduce image blurring and errors caused by patient, breathing, or organ motion. Examples include image registration, tracking, gating, and navigator methods.

Motion Perception

Motion perception is the ability of the visual, vestibular, and proprioceptive systems to detect and interpret movement of the body or surrounding objects. Disturbance may cause vertigo, oscillopsia, imbalance, or visual-motion sensitivity.

Motion Sickness

Nausea, dizziness, sweating, or vomiting caused by sensory mismatch during travel or other motion. It can occur in cars, boats, aircraft, amusement rides, or virtual-reality environments and usually improves when motion stops. Severe or persistent symptoms require assessment for other causes.

Motivation

Motivation is the set of processes that initiate, direct, and sustain goal-directed behavior. Reduced or excessive motivation may occur with mood disorders, neurologic disease, substance use, medication effects, or other conditions.

Motivational Interviewing

A collaborative counseling approach that helps a person explore mixed feelings and strengthen their own reasons for changing a health behavior. The clinician listens without judgment, asks open questions, reflects the person's views, and supports informed

choice.

Motor

Relating to movement or to the nerves and brain pathways that control movement. A motor problem may cause weakness, stiffness, poor coordination, tremor, or loss of normal control.

Motor Aphasia

Difficulty speaking or writing caused by damage to language areas of the brain, often after a stroke. A person may know what they want to say but struggle to find words, form sentences, or produce speech.

Motor Cortex

Areas at the front of the brain that plan and control voluntary movement. Each side mainly controls the opposite side of the body. Injury can cause weakness, loss of fine movement, or difficulty planning purposeful actions.

Motor Delay

Motor delay is slower-than-expected acquisition of gross- or fine-motor skills in a child. It may reflect neuromuscular, developmental, genetic, sensory, environmental, or systemic causes and warrants age-appropriate developmental assessment.

Motor End-Plate

Alternate spelling; see *Motor Endplate*.

Motor Endplate

The part of a muscle fiber where a nerve signal triggers muscle contraction. It contains receptors that respond to acetylcholine, the chemical signal released by the nerve.

Alternate Names:
Neuromuscular Junction Postsynaptic Membrane

Motor Incoordination

Impaired coordination of voluntary movement, often caused by disease affecting the cerebellum or other parts of the nervous system.

Alternate Names:
Ataxia

Motor Learning

A relatively lasting change in the ability to perform a motor skill resulting from practice, experience, feedback, and adaptation. Rehabilitation uses task-specific repetition and meaningful practice to promote motor learning.

Motor Neuron

An efferent neuron located within the central nervous system that projects its axon out of the brainstem or spinal cord to directly or indirectly innervate and control effector target tissues, predominantly skeletal muscle fibers and autonomic viscera. Classified into two fundamental tiers: (1) Upper Motor Neurons (UMNs), whose cell bodies originate in the cerebral motor cortex (primary motor cortex, Betz cells in layer V) or brainstem, whose descending axons form the corticospinal and corticobulbar tracts; UMN lesions produce muscle spasticity, hyperreflexia, clonus, extensor plantar response (positive Babinski sign), and pronator drift; and (2) Lower Motor Neurons (LMNs), whose cell bodies reside in the motor nuclei of cranial nerves or the anterior (ventral) horn of the spinal cord (alpha and gamma motor neurons) and directly synapse upon muscle fibers via the neuromuscular junction; LMN lesions produce flaccid muscle weakness, severe muscle atrophy, hypotonia, hyporeflexia or areflexia, and muscle fasciculations. Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS) is characterized pathognomonically by the combined degeneration of both upper and lower motor neurons.

Motor Neuron Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Motor Neurone Disease*.

Motor Neuron Disorders Pathology

Pathologic changes affecting upper or lower motor neurons, which may include neuronal loss, chromatolysis, gliosis, corticospinal-tract degeneration, muscle denervation atrophy, and variable involvement of brainstem or spinal motor nuclei.

Motor Neurone Disease

A group of progressive disorders affecting upper and lower motor neurons, including amyotrophic lateral sclerosis. They cause worsening weakness, muscle wasting, stiffness, cramps, and difficulty with movement; speech, swallowing, and breathing may become affected as the disease advances. Cognitive or behavioral changes occur in some forms.

Motor Neurones

Variant spelling and plural form; see *Motor Neuron*.

Motor Stereotypy

A repeated, predictable movement such as hand flapping, rocking, or body waving. It may occur during normal development or with autism, intellectual disability, neurologic disease, stress, or other conditions.

Motor Tic

A motor tic is a sudden, brief, repetitive movement such as blinking, facial grimacing, or shoulder shrugging. Tics are often temporarily suppressible and may occur in transient tic disorder, persistent tic disorder, or Tourette syndrome.

Motor Unit

One movement-controlling nerve cell and all the muscle fibers it activates. Small units allow precise movements, while large units produce more force. Damage to motor units can cause weakness, wasting, cramps, or abnormal results on nerve and muscle tests.

Motor Vehicle Accident

A collision or other road-traffic event causing injury or property damage. Medical evaluation may be needed for visible or delayed injuries, including head, neck, chest, abdominal, or musculoskeletal trauma.

Mottled Enamel

Patchy, discolored, or structurally altered tooth enamel, classically caused by excessive fluoride during tooth development.

Mottled Teeth

Teeth with irregular white, brown, or pitted enamel, often due to dental fluorosis or developmental enamel defects.

Moulage

A model, cast, or realistic reproduction of a body part or lesion used for teaching, simulation, or forensic documentation.

Mould

British spelling of mold, a multicellular fungus that grows as branching filaments.

Mountain Fever

An informal name for Colorado tick fever, a viral infection transmitted by infected Rocky Mountain wood ticks. It commonly causes fever, chills, headache, body aches, and fatigue. It is distinct from altitude illness, such as acute mountain sickness.

Mountain Sickness

Illness caused by rapid ascent to high altitude, ranging from acute mountain sickness to life-threatening pulmonary or cerebral edema.

Mouth

The oral cavity that serves as the entry point of the digestive tract, used for eating, breathing, and speaking.

Mouth Cancer

Cancer arising in the lips, gums, tongue, cheeks, floor of the mouth, palate, or other oral tissues. Most oral cavity cancers are squamous cell carcinomas.

Alternate Names:
Oral Cancer; Oral Cavity Cancer

Mouth Diseases

Disorders affecting the oral cavity, including infections, ulcers, inflammatory disease, dental disease, mucosal lesions, and tumors.

Mouth Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the oral cavity that may be benign or malignant; persistent sores, lumps, or patches can be associated with cancer.

Mouth (Oral) Cancer

Alternate name; see *Mouth Cancer*.

Mouth Sores

Painful ulcers, blisters, raw areas, or inflamed patches inside or around the mouth. Trauma, infection, immune disease, medicines, nutritional deficiency, and cancer can cause them; persistent sores can reflect an underlying condition.

Mouth-To-Mouth Resuscitation

Rescue breathing in which air is delivered from a rescuer to a person who is not breathing normally, usually as part of CPR.

Mouth Ulcer

An open sore affecting the oral lining. Causes include aphthous ulcers, trauma, infection, irritation, and systemic inflammatory disease. Many heal within two weeks; persistent, recurrent, unusually large, or firm ulcers can have an underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Oral Ulcer

Mouthwash

A liquid rinsed around the mouth and then expelled to freshen breath, deliver an active ingredient, or reduce selected oral microorganisms.

Mouthwash Overdose

Swallowing too much mouthwash may cause alcohol poisoning, vomiting, drowsiness, low blood sugar, breathing problems, or coma; products containing fluoride or other ingredients can cause additional toxicity.

Movement

Movement is a change in position of the body or a body part produced by coordinated activity of the nervous system, muscles, and joints. Abnormal movement may be excessive, reduced, involuntary, poorly coordinated, or restricted.

Movement Disorder

A neurologic condition causing excessive, reduced, or otherwise abnormal movement. Hyperkinetic disorders include tremor, dystonia, chorea, myoclonus, tics, and dyskinesia; hypokinetic disorders include bradykinesia and parkinsonism.

Movement Disorders

Alternate plural form; see *Movement Disorder*.

Movement Incoordination

Impairment in the ability to execute smooth, coordinated voluntary movements (ataxia), resulting from lesions or dysfunction within the cerebellum, spinocerebellar tracts, vestibular apparatus, or proprioceptive pathways. Manifests as dysmetria, intention tremor, and gait instability.

Alternate Names:
Ataxic Incoordination; Motor Incoordination

Moxalactam

Moxalactam is a beta-lactam antibiotic of the oxacephem group with activity against many gram-negative bacteria and some gram-positive organisms. It is rarely used today and may cause allergic reactions, diarrhea, or bleeding related to impaired coagulation.

Moxibustion

A traditional treatment that warms selected skin areas with burning mugwort or another heated material. Evidence of benefit varies by condition, and burns, smoke exposure, allergic reactions, or infection can occur.

Moxifloxacin

An antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections. It interferes with bacterial reproduction but can cause serious side effects, including tendon injury, nerve symptoms, blood-sugar changes, or dangerous heart rhythms, so use is selective.

Moyamoya Disease

A rare condition in which major arteries supplying the brain gradually narrow or close. Small fragile blood vessels form to compensate, but the condition can cause transient attacks, strokes, headaches, seizures, or thinking problems.

Moynihan's Hump

An anatomical variation in which the right hepatic artery forms an abnormally tortuous, caterpillar-like loop that extends close to the gallbladder neck and cystic duct within Calot's triangle. During gallbladder removal (cholecystectomy), this loop can be mistaken for the smaller cystic artery; accidental clipping or injury can cause severe arterial bleeding or damage blood flow to the right lobe of the liver.

Alternate Names:
Moynihan Caterpillar Turn; Caterpillar Turn of the Right Hepatic Artery; Hepatic Artery Tortuosity

MPH

Master of Public Health, a graduate degree focused on population health, disease prevention, health policy, epidemiology, and related public-health practice.

MPO

Myeloperoxidase, an enzyme in neutrophil and monocyte granules that uses hydrogen peroxide and halide ions to generate antimicrobial oxidants; MPO antibodies are also used in evaluating some autoimmune vasculitides.

Mpox

A viral disease caused by monkeypox virus, an orthopoxvirus. It spreads mainly through close contact with lesions, body fluids, respiratory particles, or contaminated objects and may cause fever, swollen lymph nodes, fatigue, and painful lesions on the skin or mucosal surfaces; severe disease is more likely in children, pregnancy, and immunocompromise.

Alternate Names:
Simian Pox; Monkeypox Virus Infection

MPS

Abbreviation for mucopolysaccharidosis, a group of inherited lysosomal storage disorders; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis*.

MPS Disorder

Alternate name; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis*.

MPS Disorder I

Alternate name; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I*.

MPS Disorder II

Alternate name; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis Type II*.

MPS I

Abbreviation; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I*.

MPS II

Abbreviation; see *Mucopolysaccharidosis Type II*.

MPTP

A toxic chemical that can permanently damage movement-controlling nerve cells and produce symptoms resembling Parkinson disease. It is mainly important in research and is not a routine medical treatment.

MRA

Magnetic resonance angiography, a noninvasive MRI-based technique that produces images of blood vessels and can help evaluate aneurysms, stenoses, malformations, and atherosclerosis.

MR Angiography

An MRI scan that creates pictures of blood vessels without using X-rays. It can help assess narrowed or blocked arteries, aneurysms, dissections, clots, and abnormal blood-vessel connections.

MRCP

Magnetic resonance cholangiopancreatography, an MRI technique that noninvasively images the bile ducts, gallbladder, and pancreatic duct without requiring endoscopic catheterization.

MRD

Minimal residual disease: a small number of malignant cells remaining after treatment, detectable by sensitive methods such as flow cytometry or PCR even when routine tests show remission.

MR Enterography

A specialized MRI scan of the small intestine after drinking contrast liquid. It can show inflammation, narrowing, fistulas, abscesses, bleeding, or other complications of Crohn disease and does not use X-rays.

MRI

Magnetic resonance imaging uses a strong magnetic field, radiofrequency energy, and computer processing to produce detailed images of body tissues without ionizing radiation. Contrast material may be used when clinically appropriate.

MRI And Low Back Pain

MRI may be used for low back pain when serious disease is suspected, neurologic deficits are present, or symptoms persist despite appropriate care; many uncomplicated cases do not need early MRI.

MRI Brain

An MRI scan used to examine the brain for tumors, stroke, bleeding, infection, inflammation, multiple sclerosis, or degenerative disease. Different settings highlight different tissues and abnormalities; contrast may be used when needed.

MRI Contrast

A contrast agent administered during magnetic resonance imaging to improve visibility of selected tissues or abnormalities.

MRI Joint

Evaluation of musculoskeletal structures: cartilage, ligaments, tendons, menisci, labrum. Knee: ACL, meniscus tears. Shoulder: rotator cuff, labrum. Hip: labral tears, FAI.

MRI Sequences

Different image settings used during an MRI scan to highlight anatomy, fluid, fat, bleeding, restricted water movement, or inflammation. Radiologists combine several settings because each shows different types of abnormality.

MRI-Targeted Fusion Prostate Biopsy

A prostate biopsy guided by combining a previous MRI with real-time ultrasound. The images help the clinician direct needles toward areas that look suspicious for cancer, sometimes along with routine samples from other areas. The procedure can cause blood in the urine or semen, infection, pain, or temporary difficulty passing urine.

Alternate Names:
Fusion Biopsy; Mri-Ultrasound Fusion Biopsy

Mrna Precursor

An initial RNA transcript that is processed by capping, splicing, and polyadenylation to form mature messenger RNA.

MR Neurography

Magnetic resonance imaging optimized to show peripheral nerves and abnormalities such as swelling, compression, or injury.

MRSA

A strain of Staphylococcus aureus resistant to several common antibiotics. It may live harmlessly on the skin or cause skin, wound, lung, bone, joint, or bloodstream infection; treatment is guided by culture results.

MRSA Decolonization

Measures intended to reduce MRSA carriage on the skin or in the nose. Protocols may include topical agents and antiseptic bathing, but the indication, regimen, and duration depend on the person's risk, infection history, setting, and local guidance.

MRSA Infection

Methicillin-resistant Staphylococcus aureus is a strain of staphylococcus resistant to several beta-

lactam antibiotics. It can colonize without illness or cause skin, wound, lung, bone, joint, or bloodstream infection; culture-guided treatment and hygiene reduce spread.

Alternate Names:
Methicillin-Resistant Staphylococcus Aureus Infection

MSA

Abbreviation for multiple system atrophy, a progressive neurodegenerative disorder affecting movement, autonomic function, and coordination; see *Multiple System Atrophy*.

MS Alternative Therapies

Complementary or nonstandard treatments used for multiple sclerosis symptoms or disease. Evidence and safety vary, some may interact with medicines, and effectiveness as a replacement for disease-modifying treatment is not established.

MSG Symptom Complex

A group of symptoms such as headache, flushing, or palpitations attributed by some people to monosodium glutamate; evidence for a consistent syndrome is limited and symptoms may have other causes.

MSL

Abbreviation for multiple symmetric lipomatosis, a disorder with symmetric deposits of fatty tissue around the neck, shoulders, or trunk; see *Multiple Symmetric Lipomatosis*.

MS (Multiple Sclerosis)

Alternate name; see *Multiple Sclerosis*.

MST

Multiple subpial transection, a neurosurgical procedure in which shallow cuts are made in the cerebral cortex to interrupt seizure pathways when the epileptogenic region cannot safely be removed.

MTOR

A protein inside cells that helps control growth, division, energy use, and response to nutrients. Medicines that block mTOR, such as rapamycin-related drugs, are used in some cancers, transplant treatments, and other selected conditions.

Mucha-Habermann Disease

An acute, severe, self-limiting variant of pityriasis lichenoides (PLEVA) characterized by the sudden eruption of widespread erythematous macules that rapidly evolve into necrotic, papulovesicular, and hemorrhagic crusted lesions that heal leaving small varioliform (pox-like) scars.

Alternate Names:
PLEVA; Pityriasis Lichenoides et Varioliformis Acuta

Mu-Chain Disease

A rare B-cell disorder in which abnormal immunoglobulin heavy chains are produced, sometimes causing anemia, enlarged lymph nodes, or other features of lymphoproliferative disease.

Mucin

Mucin is a high-molecular-weight glycoprotein that forms mucus and helps lubricate and protect epithelial surfaces. Abnormal mucin production or accumulation occurs in some respiratory, gastrointestinal, and neoplastic diseases.

Mucinoses

A group of disorders in which excessive mucin, a gel-like substance in connective tissue, builds up in the skin or other tissues. Causes may be primary, metabolic, autoimmune, or associated with another disease.

Mucinous

Mucinous means containing, producing, or resembling mucin. In pathology, the term describes lesions or tumors with extracellular or intracellular mucin and must be interpreted with the organ, architecture, and other histologic features.

Mucinous Adenocarcinoma

Mucinous adenocarcinoma is a gland-forming cancer that produces abundant mucus and can arise in

organs such as the colon, pancreas, lung, or breast.

Mucinous Borderline Ovarian Tumor

An ovarian mucinous epithelial tumor with cellular proliferation and atypia but without destructive stromal invasion; it may be large and unilateral.

Mucinous Cystadenoma

A mucinous cystadenoma is a usually benign cystic epithelial tumor that produces mucin, commonly arising in the ovary or pancreas. Large lesions may cause pain or pressure, and pathology is needed to distinguish benign from borderline or malignant mucinous tumors.

Mucinous Cystadenoma of Pancreas

An older term for a mucinous cystic neoplasm of the pancreas, a cystic growth that may be benign, precancerous, or malignant. It usually occurs in the body or tail of the pancreas, most often in women, and is assessed with imaging and sometimes tissue sampling.

Mucinous Cyst Of The Vulva

A benign mucus-filled cyst of the vulva, arising from obstruction or metaplastic mucinous epithelium in a vulvar gland or duct; persistent or atypical masses require examination and possible biopsy.

Mucinous Ovarian Carcinoma

A malignant ovarian epithelial tumor composed of invasive mucin-producing cells; metastatic gastrointestinal or pancreatobiliary carcinoma must be excluded.

Muckle-Wells Syndrome

An inherited cryopyrin-associated autoinflammatory syndrome causing recurrent fever, rash, joint or muscle pain, and progressive sensorineural hearing loss. Anti-inflammatory treatment can reduce inflammation and prevent complications.

Mucocele

A soft swelling filled with mucus. In the mouth, it usually forms when a small saliva-making gland or its tube is injured, often on the inner lower lip. The term can also describe similar swellings elsewhere in the body, so the site should be named.

Mucocele and Ranula

Mucus-filled lesions caused by leakage or blockage of a salivary gland duct. A mucocele usually affects the lower lip, while a ranula arises in the floor of the mouth; persistent, recurrent, or large lesions may need dental or oral-surgery treatment.

Mucociliary Escalator

The system of mucus and tiny moving hairs (cilia) lining the airways. Mucus traps dust and germs, and cilia move it toward the throat so it can be swallowed or coughed out.

Mucocutaneous Leishmaniasis

A chronic, mutilating metastatic form of leishmaniasis caused by New World species of the Leishmania subgenus Viannia (principally Leishmania braziliensis), which disseminates from a primary cutaneous ulcer to mucosal tissues through hematogenous or lymphatic routes. It causes progressive, destructive granulomatous ulceration and cartilaginous necrosis of the nasal septum, palate, pharynx, and larynx, clinically presenting with nasal obstruction, epistaxis, septal perforation, and severe facial disfigurement.

Alternate Names:
Espundia; American Mucocutaneous Leishmaniasis; Nasopharyngeal Leishmaniasis

Mucocutaneous Lymph Node Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Kawasaki Disease*.

Mucoepidermoid Carcinoma

Mucoepidermoid carcinoma is a cancer containing mucus-producing and squamous-like cells, most often arising in salivary glands or the lungs.

Mucoid

Resembling mucus or having a thick, slippery, mucus-like appearance. The word describes a substance or finding and does not by itself identify its cause.

Mucolipidoses

A group of inherited lysosomal storage disorders in which cells cannot properly process certain lipids and carbohydrate-containing substances. Material accumulates in tissues and may cause developmental delay, skeletal changes, vision problems, and organ disease.

Mucolipidosis II Alpha/Beta

A severe, autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder caused by pathogenic variants in *GNPTAB*, which disrupt the tagging and delivery of lysosomal enzymes. Enzyme deficiency within lysosomes leads to widespread cellular storage and progressive disease beginning in infancy. Features may include poor growth, developmental impairment, skeletal abnormalities, and heart or respiratory problems. The older name is I-cell disease.

Alternate Names:
Mucolipidosis Type II; ML II Alpha/Beta; I-Cell Disease

Mucolytics

Medicines that make thick mucus thinner and easier to clear from the airways. They may help some people cough up mucus, but treatment depends on the cause of congestion and the person's overall condition.

Mucolytic Therapy

Treatment that makes thick mucus easier to move and cough up. Different medicines work by breaking mucus proteins, removing extra DNA, or drawing water into airway secretions; the choice depends on the disease and the person's ability to clear mucus.

Mucopolysaccharides

Long chains of sugar molecules that form part of connective tissue and help support joints, skin, cartilage, and other structures. Inherited problems breaking them down can cause storage diseases.

Mucopolysaccharidoses

A group of inherited lysosomal storage diseases in which glycosaminoglycans accumulate because one of several degradation enzymes is deficient. The disorders can affect the skeleton, joints, airways, heart, eyes, abdominal organs, and nervous system, with severity varying by type.

Mucopolysaccharidosis

The singular name for any of a group of inherited lysosomal storage disorders in which glycosaminoglycans accumulate because of deficient enzyme activity. Types differ in their genetic cause, age of onset, and effects on the skeleton, organs, airways, eyes, heart, and nervous system.

Mucopolysaccharidosis Type I

An inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient alpha-L-iduronidase, usually because of disease-causing variants in the *IDUA* gene. It ranges from severe Hurler syndrome through attenuated Hurler-Scheie and Scheie phenotypes and may affect the skeleton, airways, heart, eyes, abdominal organs, and nervous system.

Mucopolysaccharidosis Type II

Mucopolysaccharidosis type II, or Hunter syndrome, is an X-linked iduronate-2-sulfatase deficiency causing accumulation of glycosaminoglycans and multisystem disease.

Mucopolysaccharidosis Type III

Mucopolysaccharidosis type III, or Sanfilippo syndrome, is an inherited disorder of heparan-sulfate breakdown causing progressive neurodevelopmental and behavioral decline.

Mucopolysaccharidosis Type IV

Mucopolysaccharidosis type IV, or Morquio syndrome, is an inherited disorder of keratan-sulfate breakdown causing skeletal and connective-tissue abnormalities with variable neurologic involvement.

Mucopolysaccharidosis VII

Mucopolysaccharidosis VII, or Sly syndrome, is a lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient beta-glucuronidase activity. Accumulation of glycosaminoglycans can cause skeletal, connective-tissue, visceral, developmental, and sometimes neurologic abnormalities.

Mucopus

A mixture of mucus and pus produced by inflammation or infection. It may appear in the nose, sinuses, airways, bowel, cervix, or other mucus-lined areas; its significance varies with symptoms and location.

Mucor

Mucor is a genus of molds; related Mucorales fungi can cause mucormycosis, a serious invasive infection mainly in people with severe immune or metabolic problems.

Mucorales

Mucorales is an order of molds that includes fungi capable of causing mucormycosis, a rapidly invasive infection of the sinuses, lungs, skin, or other tissues.

Mucormycosis

A rare but rapidly destructive infection caused by certain molds. It most often affects people with severely weakened immunity or uncontrolled diabetes and can damage the sinuses, eyes, lungs, skin, brain, or several organs.

Mucor Ramosissimus

A type of mold found in the environment that rarely causes infection in people. When infection occurs, it is usually in someone with severely weakened immune defenses and requires identification of the fungus and specialist treatment.

Mucosa

Mucosa is the moist epithelial lining of body passages such as the mouth, nose, airways, gastrointestinal tract, and reproductive or urinary tracts.

Mucosa-Associated Lymphoid Tissue

Collections of immune tissue in the moist linings of the digestive, breathing, and urinary or reproductive tracts. They help detect and respond to substances and germs entering through these surfaces.

Mucosa-Associated Lymphoid Tissue Lymphoma

Alternate name; see *MALT Lymphoma*.

Mucosal

Relating to a mucous membrane, the moist lining of areas such as the mouth, nose, airways, digestive tract, and genital or urinary tract. Mucosa helps protect tissues, produce mucus, absorb substances in some organs, and support local immune defense.

Mucosal Candidiasis

Candida yeast infection of a mucous membrane, commonly producing white plaques, soreness, redness, or burning in the mouth or genital tract. Antibiotics, diabetes, inhaled steroids, immune suppression, and moisture can increase risk.

Mucosal Immunity

Mucosal immunity is immune defense at surfaces lining the respiratory, gastrointestinal, genitourinary, and other tracts. It includes epithelial barriers, mucus, secretory IgA, antimicrobial molecules, innate cells, and locally regulated adaptive responses.

Mucosal Infection

An infection involving a moist epithelial lining such as the mouth, eye, nose, airway, gastrointestinal tract, or genital tract.

Mucosal Irritation

Inflammation or injury of moist linings in the eyes, nose, throat, mouth, stomach, or intestines. It may cause burning, pain, redness, swelling, or sores after chemicals, medicines, infection, or friction.

Mucosal Melanoma

A melanoma arising from melanocytes in mucosal surfaces such as the sinonasal tract, oral cavity, anorectal region, or genital tract; it is uncommon and often diagnosed at an advanced stage.

Mucosal Warts

Warts caused by human papillomavirus on moist lining tissues such as the mouth, genitals, or anus. They may be painless or cause itching, bleeding, or discomfort. Most genital warts are caused by low-risk HPV types; other mucosal HPV types can cause cancer.

Mucositis

Painful inflammation and sores in the moist lining of the mouth or digestive tract, often after chemotherapy or radiation. It can make eating and swallowing difficult and may increase the risk of infection.

Mucous

Relating to mucus, the viscous fluid produced by mucous membranes and glands that lubricates surfaces and helps trap particles and microorganisms.

Mucous Cysts

Small fluid-filled lumps near the end joint of a finger, often associated with osteoarthritis. They may cause tenderness, nail changes, or leakage; puncturing can introduce infection.

Alternate Names:
Digital Mucous Cyst; Myxoid Cyst

Mucous Membrane

A moist tissue lining body cavities that open to the outside, including the nose, mouth, and lungs.

Alternate Names:
Mucosa

Mucous Membrane (Cicatricial) Pemphigoid (MMP)

A group of autoimmune subepidermal blistering disorders affecting mucous membranes, especially the mouth, eyes, nose, and genitals. Repeated inflammation can scar and threaten vision, airway function, or other organ function, so specialist diagnosis and treatment are important.

Mucous Membrane Pemphigoid

A chronic autoimmune subepidermal blistering disease affecting mucous membranes, especially the eyes and mouth; scarring can impair vision or function.

Mucus

Mucus is a viscoelastic secretion containing water, mucin glycoproteins, salts, antimicrobial factors, and cellular material. It lubricates and protects epithelial surfaces and traps particles and microorganisms for clearance.

Mucus Plugging

Accumulation of thick mucus in an airway that partly or completely blocks airflow. It can occur in asthma, cystic fibrosis, bronchiectasis, and other lung diseases and may cause breathlessness, infection, or collapse of part of a lung. Treatment depends on the cause and may include airway-clearance methods or medicines that open the airways or thin mucus.

Mud Fever

A historical name sometimes used for leptospirosis, a bacterial infection caused by pathogenic *Leptospira*. People can acquire it through contact with water or soil contaminated by urine from infected animals. The name is imprecise; *leptospirosis* is the current disease name.

Muehrcke Lines

Paired, white, non-palpable, transverse parallel bands spanning the width of the nail bed, separated by normal pink nail bed, which do not migrate with nail growth and blanch with digital pressure (apparent leukonychia), characteristic of severe hypoalbuminemia (serum albumin less than 2 g/dL).

Muehrcke's Lines

Alternate name; see *Muehrcke Lines*.

Median Canaliform Nail Dystrophy

A nail change with a central lengthwise groove or split and slanted crosswise ridges that form a fir-tree pattern. It often affects the thumbnails and may follow repeated minor injury to the nail matrix. It can resemble damage from a habit-tic deformity.

Alternate Names:
Muehrcke's Lines; Paired White Bands of Hypoalbuminemia

Muehrcke Lines of the Fingernails

Paired transverse white bands in the nail bed that remain fixed as the nail grows. They may occur with low blood protein, severe illness, chemotherapy, or other systemic stress and usually improve when

the underlying problem resolves.

Muehrcke's Nails

Paired transverse white bands in the nail beds, usually associated with hypoalbuminemia or other systemic illness. The bands remain fixed as the nail grows because they arise from the nail bed rather than the nail plate.

Muenke Syndrome

A craniosynostosis syndrome caused by a pathogenic FGFR3 variant. Premature fusion of one or more skull sutures may produce an abnormal head shape and can be accompanied by developmental, hearing, limb, or neurological findings.

MUGA Scan

A heart scan that uses a small radioactive tracer and records the heart's pumping with each heartbeat. It measures how much blood the main chambers pump and can assess wall movement.

Alternate Names:
Radionuclide Angiography; Radionuclide Ventriculography

Muir-Torre Syndrome

An autosomal dominant cancer predisposition syndrome (a variant of Lynch syndrome) caused by germline mutations in DNA mismatch repair genes (MSH2, MLH1), characterized by the combination of at least one sebaceous gland neoplasm (sebaceous adenoma, sebaceoma) or keratoacanthomas with internal visceral malignancies (especially colorectal and genitourinary carcinomas).

Alternate Names:
MTS; Sebaceous Neoplasm and Visceral Cancer Syndrome

Mulberry Molars

Permanent back teeth with many small, rounded, irregular cusps. They are classically linked with congenital syphilis but can also result from other developmental problems affecting tooth formation before birth.

Mulibrey Nanism

Mulibrey nanism is a rare inherited multisystem disorder, usually caused by biallelic variants in *TRIM37*. It may cause severe growth restriction, characteristic facial features, pericardial or hepatic disease, insulin resistance, and other organ involvement.

Muller Cells

Supporting glial cells of the retina that help nourish retinal nerve cells and maintain the retina's structure and chemical environment.

Mullerian Agenesis

A congenital condition in which the uterus, cervix, and upper part of the vagina are absent or underdeveloped, usually with normal ovarian function and puberty. It often presents as primary amenorrhea.

Alternate Names:
Mayer-Rokitansky-Kuster-Hauser Syndrome; MRKH Syndrome; Mayer-Rokitansky-Küster-Hauser Syndrome

Mullerian Duct Anomalies

Congenital differences in development of the uterus, cervix, fallopian tubes, or upper vagina. Examples include septate, bicornuate, didelphys, unicornuate, and agenesis patterns; they may cause menstrual obstruction, infertility, pregnancy loss, or preterm birth.

Multicenter Study

A multicenter study is a clinical or research investigation conducted at two or more sites under a coordinated protocol. It can improve enrollment and generalizability but requires harmonized methods, quality control, and site-specific oversight.

Multicentric

Having more than one center or focus; in oncology, describing separate primary tumor foci, often also called multifocal or polycentric.

Multicentric Reticulohistiocytosis

A rare systemic non-Langerhans cell histiocytosis

characterized by papulonodular skin or mucosal lesions and often destructive inflammatory arthritis. It may involve other organs and can be associated with an underlying malignancy, so evaluation is multidisciplinary.

Multicystic Dysplastic Kidney

A birth defect in which one kidney develops as a cluster of cysts and has little or no working tissue. The other kidney often provides most kidney function but may also need monitoring for related urinary problems.

Multidetector Computed Tomography

A CT scan that uses many detectors to collect multiple thin image slices at the same time. It produces detailed pictures quickly and is useful for injuries, blood vessels, organs, and some virtual examinations, but uses X-rays.

Multidisciplinary Disaster Victim Identification

The coordinated process of identifying victims of mass-fatality incidents (natural disasters, transport crashes, terrorist attacks) using multiple disciplines: fingerprinting, dental records, DNA profiling, forensic anthropology/radiology, and personal effects, with ante-mortem data collection and comparison.

Multidisciplinary Team

Healthcare professionals from different fields who work together on one person's care. Depending on the problem, the team may include doctors, nurses, therapists, pharmacists, psychologists, dietitians, and social workers.

Multidrug-Resistant TB

Tuberculosis caused by bacteria resistant to at least the two most important first-line medicines, isoniazid and rifampin. It needs specialized medicines, susceptibility testing, and close monitoring because treatment is harder and may last many months.

Multidrug-Resistant Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis caused by bacteria resistant to at least isoniazid and rifampicin, two important tuberculosis medicines. It requires specialist testing and a longer combination treatment chosen according to drug-susceptibility results.

Multienzyme Complexes

Groups of enzymes organized together so that several steps in a chemical pathway occur efficiently. This arrangement can speed reactions, limit loss of intermediates, and coordinate metabolism inside cells.

Multifactorial

Caused or influenced by several factors rather than one single cause. These may include genes, age, lifestyle, infections, medicines, environment, and other health conditions, with each factor adding to the overall risk.

Multifocal

Arising from or involving two or more distinct foci or sites, such as separate tumor foci or vascular lesions.

Multifocal Atrial Tachycardia

An atrial tachyarrhythmia with at least three distinct P-wave morphologies, irregular rhythm, and a rate above 100 beats per minute. It is strongly associated with severe pulmonary disease, hypoxia, and metabolic stress.

Multifocal Motor Neuropathy

A rare, chronic, acquired autoimmune peripheral neuropathy characterized by slowly progressive, asymmetric, distal lower motor neuron weakness and muscle atrophy predominantly affecting the upper extremities without sensory loss. Characterized electrophysiologically by persistent multifocal motor conduction blocks outside usual entrapment sites, with high circulating titers of IgM anti-GM1 ganglioside antibodies in over 50 percent of patients; responds selectively to intravenous immunoglobulin.

Alternate Names:
MMN; Multifocal Motor Neuropathy with Conduction Block

Multigravida

A person who has been pregnant two or more times, including pregnancies that did not continue.

Multi-Infarct Dementia

A decline in memory and thinking caused by several strokes that damage different parts of the brain. Problems may include slowed thinking, poor planning, mood changes, walking difficulty, or memory loss; the term is now often included under vascular cognitive impairment.

Multilocular

Having several separate spaces or compartments. The word may describe a cyst, tumor, or other lesion seen on imaging; its significance depends on the organ involved, the appearance of the walls, and the person's symptoms.

Multi-Minicore Disease

A rare inherited muscle disorder in which muscle fibers contain multiple small areas of damage. It can cause low muscle tone, weakness, spinal curvature, and breathing problems.

Alternate Names:
MmD; Minicore Myopathy; Multicore Disease

Multimodal Analgesia

Use of analgesic techniques with different mechanisms to improve pain control while reducing reliance on any single drug, especially opioids. Components may include acetaminophen, nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs, regional anesthesia, local anesthetics, and selected adjuvants.

Multimodal Imaging

Use of two or more imaging methods, such as CT, MRI, ultrasound, or nuclear imaging, to examine the same disease or body region. Combining methods can provide complementary structural, functional, or molecular information.

Multimorbidity

The coexistence of two or more chronic health conditions in the same person, without requiring one to be considered the primary disease. It complicates treatment, increases polypharmacy risk, and requires coordinated patient-centered care.

Multinodular Goiter

An enlarged thyroid containing multiple nodules. Thyroid function may be normal, underactive, or overactive; evaluation commonly includes thyroid-function tests and ultrasound, with further assessment of suspicious nodules or compressive symptoms.

Multinucleated Hepatocyte

A multinucleated hepatocyte is a liver cell containing two or more nuclei, usually from nuclear division without complete cytokinesis. It may be a normal or reactive finding, but its significance depends on the number, morphology, and associated liver abnormalities.

Multipara

A person who has had two or more pregnancies that reached the stage of potential fetal viability, regardless of whether the pregnancies resulted in live births.

Multiparametric MRI Of The Prostate

A detailed prostate MRI that combines several types of images to show prostate structure, water movement, and blood flow. It helps identify suspicious areas and guide biopsy or treatment, but an abnormal scan does not by itself prove cancer.

Multiparous

Having given birth two or more times to a fetus or fetuses beyond the stage of viability.

Multiple Bacterial Abscesses

Several pockets of pus caused by bacterial infection in one or more organs. They may develop when bacteria spread through the blood or extend from nearby tissue and can cause fever, pain, or organ problems; imaging helps locate them.

Multiple Biliary Hamartomas

Multiple small, harmless birth-related changes in the liver's bile ducts that look like tiny cysts on scans. They usually cause no symptoms and are often found by chance, but imaging helps distinguish them from cancer or other liver disease.

Multiple Endocrine Deficiency Syndrome

A syndrome involving deficiency of more than one endocrine hormone, caused by autoimmune, genetic, pituitary, hypothalamic, or other disease; evaluation identifies which glands are affected.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia

A group of inherited, usually autosomal dominant cancer-predisposition syndromes causing tumors or overactivity in two or more hormone-making glands during a person's lifetime. Types include MEN1, MEN2, and related subtypes with different gene associations and tumor risks.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia I

MEN type 1 is an inherited tumor syndrome involving parathyroid, pituitary, and pancreatic or duodenal neuroendocrine tumors, often caused by MEN1 variants.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia II

MEN type 2 is an inherited syndrome with medullary thyroid cancer, pheochromocytoma, and sometimes parathyroid disease, commonly involving RET variants.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 1

An inherited condition that causes tumors in several hormone-making organs, especially the parathyroid glands, pituitary gland, and pancreas or nearby intestine. It is usually caused by a change in the MEN1 gene and requires lifelong monitoring.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2

An inherited condition that greatly increases the risk of medullary thyroid cancer and may cause adrenal or parathyroid tumors. Type 2B can also cause nerve-related mouth bumps and distinctive body features; lifelong specialist monitoring is needed.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2A

An inherited condition that greatly increases the risk of medullary thyroid cancer and can also cause adrenal tumors and overactive parathyroid glands. Regular genetic and specialist monitoring helps detect these problems early.

Alternate Names:
MEN 2A; MEN2A; Sipple Syndrome

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2B

An inherited RET-associated syndrome characterized by medullary thyroid carcinoma, pheochromocytoma, mucosal neuromas, and a marfanoid habitus. The thyroid-cancer risk is high and requires early specialist genetic and surgical assessment.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 2 (MEN2)

An inherited cancer-predisposition syndrome, usually caused by a pathogenic RET variant, featuring medullary thyroid carcinoma and, in some people, pheochromocytoma and parathyroid disease. Genetic counseling, biochemical testing, and preventive thyroid surgery may be needed.

Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 4

A rare, autosomal dominant inherited tumor syndrome caused by germline mutations in the *CDKN1B* gene, which encodes the $p27^{Kip1}$ tumor suppressor protein. It presents with features overlapping with MEN1, most commonly characterized by primary hyperparathyroidism (parathyroid adenomas causing high blood calcium) and anterior pituitary adenomas (such as prolactinomas or growth hormone-secreting tumors). Patients may also develop pancreatic neuroendocrine tumors, adrenal adenomas, and reproductive organ tumors. It is typically diagnosed in patients with MEN1-like symptoms who test negative for mutations in the *MEN1* gene.

Alternate Names:
MEN 4; MEN4; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type IV; CDKN1B-Related MEN

Multiple Exostoses

Multiple exostoses, or hereditary multiple osteo-

chondromas, is an inherited disorder causing multiple cartilage-capped bony projections near growth plates. Lesions can deform bones, restrict motion, compress nerves or vessels, and rarely undergo malignant transformation.

Multiple Fibrofolliculomas

Numerous harmless small skin-colored growths arising from hair follicles, usually on the face and trunk. They can be a sign of Birt-Hogg-Dubé syndrome, which also increases the risk of kidney tumors and collapsed lung.

Multiple Inherited Schwannomas

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 2*.

Multiple Lentigines Syndrome

An inherited disorder causing numerous lentigines with variable heart, endocrine, eye, hearing, or developmental abnormalities; it may overlap with Noonan-spectrum syndromes.

Multiple Mononeuropathy

Damage to several separate nerves in different parts of the body, often developing unevenly. It can cause patchy pain, numbness, weakness, or muscle wasting and may result from blood-vessel inflammation, diabetes, infection, or another systemic disease.

Multiple Myeloma

A type of cancer that begins in plasma cells, white blood cells in the bone marrow that normally produce antibodies to fight infection. In multiple myeloma, abnormal plasma cells multiply uncontrollably, crowding out healthy blood cells and producing large amounts of a faulty antibody protein. This can lead to bone thinning, painful fractures, high blood calcium levels, anemia, recurrent infections, and kidney damage.

Alternate Names:
Plasma Cell Myeloma; Kahler Disease; Myelomatosis

Multiple Myeloma: Deadly To Chronic

Multiple myeloma is a plasma-cell cancer that produces a monoclonal protein and can cause bone lesions, anemia, kidney injury, high calcium, infections, and fatigue. It is often treatable as a chronic illness, though relapse and complications remain possible.

Multiple Organ Dysfunction Syndrome

Abnormal function of two or more organs during severe illness, such as sepsis, shock, trauma, or pancreatitis. Organ function may worsen over time and requires close monitoring and treatment of the underlying cause.

Multiple Organ Failure

A life-threatening condition in which two or more organs stop working properly, usually during severe infection, shock, injury, or widespread inflammation. Intensive care supports the organs while doctors treat the underlying cause.

Multiple Peripheral Neuritis

Inflammation or injury affecting multiple peripheral nerves, causing pain, numbness, weakness, or autonomic symptoms; see *Peripheral Neuritis*.

Multiple Polyposis of the Colon

Development of many colorectal polyps, which may be inherited or acquired and may increase colorectal cancer risk; see *Polyposis*.

Multiple Gestation

A pregnancy involving two or more fetuses developing simultaneously in the uterus; see *Multiple Pregnancy*.

Multiple Pregnancy

A pregnancy involving two or more fetuses. Twins may develop from two separate eggs or from one fertilized egg that divides; triplets and higher-order pregnancies are less common. Multiple pregnancies have higher risks of premature birth, growth problems, and pregnancy complications and require closer monitoring.

Multiple Pregnancy: Twins or More

Alternate name; see *Multiple Pregnancy*.

Multiple Sclerosis

A chronic autoimmune disease of the central nervous system in which the body's immune defenses mistakenly attack myelin, the protective fatty coating around nerve fibers in the brain and spinal cord. This damage interferes with the transmission of electrical nerve signals, resulting in varied symptoms that can include muscle weakness, numbness or tingling, balance and coordination problems, vision changes, and chronic fatigue.

Alternate Names:
MS; Disseminated Sclerosis

Multiple Sclerosis (MS)

Alternate name; see *Multiple Sclerosis*.

Multiple Sclerosis MS And Pregnancy

Multiple sclerosis usually does not prevent pregnancy, but symptoms, disease-modifying medicines, relapse risk, delivery planning, and postpartum care require coordination. Some treatments must be stopped or changed, and relapse risk can shift after delivery.

Multiple Sleep Latency Test

A daytime sleep study measuring how quickly a person falls asleep during several scheduled nap opportunities. It helps evaluate excessive daytime sleepiness and narcolepsy after nighttime sleep has been assessed.

Multiple Sulfatase Deficiency

A rare inherited lysosomal-storage disorder caused by deficient activation of multiple sulfatase enzymes, producing progressive neurologic, skeletal, skin, and organ disease.

Multiple Symmetric Lipomatosis

A disorder characterized by symmetric, usually nonencapsulated fatty deposits around the neck, shoulders, upper trunk, or proximal limbs. It may be associated with alcohol use or metabolic and neurologic disorders.

Alternate Names:
Madelung Disease

Multiple System Atrophy

A progressive brain disorder affecting movement, coordination, and automatic body functions. It may cause stiffness and slowness, poor balance, fainting from low blood pressure, bladder problems, speech changes, or difficulty swallowing.

Alternate Names:
MSA

Multiple System Atrophy Cerebellar Type

An adult-onset neurodegenerative synucleinopathy (MSA-C) characterized primarily by progressive cerebellar ataxia (gait instability, limb dysmetria, dysarthria, oculomotor abnormalities) accompanied by severe autonomic failure and variable pyramidal signs.

Alternate Names:
MSA-C; Cerebellar Multiple System Atrophy; Olivopontocerebellar Atrophy Variant

Multiple System Atrophy Parkinsonian Type

A progressive neurodegenerative disorder (MSA-P) characterized predominantly by parkinsonian features (rigidity, akinesia, postural instability) that respond poorly to levodopa, combined with early severe autonomic failure (orthostatic hypotension, urinary incontinence) and variable pyramidal dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
MSA-P; Parkinsonian Multiple System Atrophy; Striatonigral Degeneration Variant

Multiple System Failure

Failure of two or more organ systems, also called multiple-organ failure or multiple-organ dysfunction syndrome; it may occur during severe illness such as sepsis, shock, or major trauma.

Multiple Vitamin Overdose

Taking too many multivitamins can cause poisoning, especially from iron, vitamin A, or vitamin D. Symptoms may include vomiting, abdominal pain, confusion, liver injury, kidney injury, or dangerous calcium levels; severe poisoning can be life-

threatening.

Multiplex PCR Panel

A laboratory test that looks for genetic material from several germs in one sample. Different panels test respiratory, intestinal, blood, or other specimens; a detected germ may represent infection, harmless carriage, or material left after an infection.

Alternate Names:
Multiplex Polymerase Chain Reaction; Syndromic Molecular Panel

Multiplicity

Multiplicity is the state of having more than one occurrence, copy, lesion, tumor, or pregnancy component. Its interpretation depends on context, such as multiple gestation, multifocal disease, or copy number in genetics.

Multipolar Neuron

A nerve cell with one long output branch and several receiving branches. This common type of neuron includes many cells that control movement or pass signals within the brain and spinal cord.

Multisystem Inflammatory Syndrome In Children

A serious delayed inflammatory illness occurring in some children after infection with SARS-CoV-2, involving fever and two or more organ systems and potentially causing shock or cardiac dysfunction.

Multivesicular Body

A multivesicular body is an endosomal compartment containing many small intraluminal vesicles. It can fuse with the plasma membrane to release exosomes or with a lysosome to degrade its cargo.

Multivisceral Transplant

Transplantation of several abdominal organs, commonly the stomach, small intestine, pancreas, and liver, from a donor to a recipient with irreversible intestinal failure or complex abdominal disease. Lifelong immunosuppression and specialist monitoring are required because rejection, infection, graft dysfunction, and surgical complications can occur.

Mumps

A contagious viral infection spread through respiratory droplets and saliva. It often causes fever, headache, fatigue, and tender swelling of one or both parotid salivary glands, making chewing and swallowing painful. Complications include orchitis, meningitis, pancreatitis, and hearing loss, and are less common in vaccinated people. Treatment is usually supportive. Two doses of measles-mumps-rubella (MMR) vaccine reduce the risk but do not prevent every infection.

Alternate Names:
Epidemic Parotitis; Mumps Parotitis

Mumps Orchitis

Inflammation of one or both testes during mumps infection, usually in postpubertal males. It causes testicular pain and swelling and may lead to testicular atrophy. CDC estimates it occurs in about 30

Mumps Parotitis

Alternate name; see *Mumps*.

Mumps Virus

The virus that causes mumps, a contagious infection spread through saliva and respiratory droplets. It commonly causes fever and painful swelling near the jaw, and can sometimes inflame the brain, pancreas, or reproductive organs; vaccination reduces risk.

Munchausen Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Factitious Disorder*.

Munchausen Syndrome by Proxy

Older name for factitious disorder imposed on another, in which a caregiver falsifies, exaggerates, or induces illness in another person; see *Factitious Disorder Imposed on Another*.

Mupirocin

Mupirocin is a topical antibiotic that inhibits bacterial isoleucyl-tRNA synthetase. It is used for selected skin infections and nasal eradication of certain staphylococci; resistance can develop with

inappropriate or prolonged use.

Mural

Relating to a wall, especially the wall of a body cavity, organ, or blood vessel.

Mural Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot along the wall of a heart chamber or blood vessel rather than freely within the lumen.

Mural Thrombus

A mural thrombus is a blood clot that forms on the wall of a heart chamber or large blood vessel, typically in areas of damaged endothelium, stasis, or turbulent flow.

Muramidase

Muramidase, or lysozyme, is an enzyme that cleaves the peptidoglycan backbone of bacterial cell walls. It is present in secretions and innate immune cells and contributes to defense against susceptible bacteria.

Murine Typhus

An acute endemic rickettsial illness caused by Rickettsia typhi and transmitted to humans primarily through the feces of infected rodent fleas (Xenopsylla cheopis). It typically presents with high prolonged fever, severe frontal headache, myalgias, arthralgias, and a maculopapular rash that typically spares the face, palms, and soles.

Alternate Names:
Endemic Typhus; Flea-Borne Typhus

Murk Jansen Metaphyseal Chondrodysplasia

Alternate name for Jansen metaphyseal chondrodysplasia; see *Jansen Metaphyseal Chondrodysplasia*.

Murmur

An extra sound heard during a heartbeat, usually caused by fast or turbulent blood flow through the heart or nearby blood vessels. Some murmurs are harmless, while others may be caused by heart valve or structural problems.

Murmur Classification

Heart murmurs are classified by timing, grade, shape, location, radiation, and pitch. Timing: systolic (between S1 and S2), diastolic (between S2 and S1), or continuous. Grade: I (barely audible) to VI (heard without stethoscope). Shape: crescendo, decrescendo, or plateau.

Murphy Sign

A sudden catch or stop in breathing when a doctor presses under the right ribcage as the patient takes a deep breath in, indicating an inflamed gallbladder.

Murphy's Sign

Inspiratory arrest caused by pain when the right upper quadrant is palpated, traditionally suggesting acute cholecystitis.

Musca

A fly genus including the housefly; some species can spread germs by carrying them on their bodies.

Muscae Volitantes

Moving spots, threads, or cobweb-like shapes seen in the visual field, usually caused by shadows from vitreous opacities.

Muscarine

Muscarine is a mushroom-derived agonist of muscarinic acetylcholine receptors. Ingestion of muscarine-containing mushrooms can cause a cholinergic syndrome with salivation, sweating, tearing, abdominal cramps, vomiting, diarrhea, bronchospasm, and bradycardia.

Muscarinic Antagonist

A muscarinic antagonist blocks acetylcholine at muscarinic receptors in smooth muscle, glands, the heart, and the central nervous system. Examples include atropine, ipratropium, and oxybutynin; effects can include dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, tachycardia, and confusion.

Alternate Names:
Antimuscarinic

Muscidae

Muscidae is a family of flies that includes the housefly. Some species can mechanically carry pathogens to food or wounds, and their larvae may occasionally cause myiasis.

Muscimol

Muscimol is a psychoactive compound found in some Amanita mushrooms and an agonist at GABA-A receptors. Ingestion can cause altered perception, sedation, agitation, incoordination, or seizures and may require toxicologic evaluation.

Muscle

Body tissue that shortens to create force and movement. Skeletal muscle moves the bones and supports posture, heart muscle pumps blood, and smooth muscle moves substances through organs such as the bowel and blood vessels.

Muscle Aches

Pain or soreness in one or more muscles. Common causes include overuse, injury, infection, medicines, and conditions affecting the whole body.

Muscle Atrophy

Loss or wasting of muscle tissue caused by disuse, nerve injury, inflammation, malnutrition, or systemic disease. It may lead to weakness and reduced function; treatment focuses on the cause, nutrition, and appropriately supervised rehabilitation.

Muscle Belly

The thick, fleshy middle part of a muscle between its attached ends. It contains most of the muscle fibers that shorten to produce force.

Muscle Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of skeletal muscle for microscopic, histochemical, immunologic, or molecular examination in suspected myopathy, inflammation, infection, or infiltrative disease.

Muscle Cell

A cell specialized to contract; skeletal, cardiac, and smooth muscle cells perform different movement and organ functions.

Muscle Contraction

The tightening of a muscle, allowing it to produce force or movement. Muscle fibers use calcium and energy from ATP to make their protein filaments slide against each other.

Muscle-Contraction Headache

A pressure-like headache caused by prolonged tightening or sensitivity of muscles in the scalp, neck, or jaw. Stress, poor posture, fatigue, or jaw clenching may contribute; frequent, severe, or changing headaches need medical assessment.

Alternate Names:
Tension-Type Headache; Stress Headache

Muscle Contracture

Persistent shortening or tightening of a muscle or nearby tissues that limits joint movement and does not fully relax with stretching. It may follow scarring, prolonged spasticity, immobility, injury, or, more rarely, a muscle-energy disorder.

Alternate Names:
Skeletal Muscle Contracture; Metabolic Contracture

Muscle Cramp

A muscle cramp is a sudden, involuntary, painful contraction of a muscle. It may follow exertion, dehydration, electrolyte disturbance, pregnancy, medication use, nerve disease, or vascular disease; recurrent cramps need assessment of the cause.

Muscle Cramps

Alternate plural form; see *Muscle Cramp*.

Alternate Names:
Charley Horse; Involuntary Muscle Spasm

Muscle Development

Muscle development is the formation, growth, differentiation, and maturation of muscle tissue. It depends on genetic programs, neural input, hormones, nutrition, mechanical loading, and repair processes.

Muscle Disorder

A disease affecting muscle structure or function, causing weakness, pain, cramps, stiffness, wasting, or abnormal movement. Causes include inherited conditions, inflammation, nerve disease, medicines, infection, and metabolic problems.

Muscle Fascicle

A bundle of muscle fibers surrounded by connective tissue. Several fascicles join to form a muscle.

Muscle Fatigue

A reduced ability of a muscle to produce force after prolonged or repeated activity. It may result from exertion, poor sleep, illness, medicines, nerve problems, or muscle disease, and improves when the cause is treated.

Muscle Fiber

A single multinucleated, elongated, cylindrical contractile cell of skeletal muscle tissue (myocyte), formed embryologically by the end-to-end fusion of multiple mononucleated mesodermal myoblasts. Enclosed by an excitable plasma membrane (sarcolemma) and an external basal lamina (endomysium), each muscle fiber contains numerous peripherally displaced nuclei, an extensive sarcoplasmic reticulum network for calcium storage and release, transverse tubules (T-tubules) for action potential propagation, and bundles of longitudinally arranged myofibrils composed of repeating contractile units called sarcomeres (demarcated by Z-discs, containing interdigitating actin thin filaments and myosin thick filaments). Functionally classified into two major physiological types: Type I fibers (slow-twitch, oxidative, rich in mitochondria and myoglobin, fatigue-resistant, suited for sustained posture and endurance); and Type II fibers (fast-twitch, glycolytic, specialized for rapid, high-force anaerobic bursts, further subdivided into Type IIa [fast oxidative-glycolytic] and Type IIx/IIb [fast glycolytic]).

Muscle Fibers

Plural form; see *Muscle Fiber*.

Muscle Function Loss

Reduced ability of a muscle or muscle group to generate movement or force, caused by muscle disease, nerve injury, neuromuscular-junction disorders, pain, or disuse.

Muscle Hypertrophy

Muscle hypertrophy is enlargement of individual muscle fibers, usually in response to resistance, hormonal stimulation, or compensatory workload. It can be physiologic or associated with disease, depending on the muscle and cause.

Muscle Insertion

The attachment of a muscle to the body part that usually moves when the muscle contracts. The insertion is often farther from the body's center than the muscle's origin.

Muscle-Invasive Bladder Cancer

Bladder cancer that has grown into the bladder muscle layer. It has a greater risk of spreading than cancer limited to the bladder lining and is classified by examination of bladder tissue.

Muscle Neoplasm

A muscle neoplasm is an abnormal growth in skeletal or smooth muscle or nearby soft tissue and may be benign or malignant.

Muscle Origin

The attachment of a muscle to the body part that usually stays more fixed when the muscle contracts. It is often closer to the body's center than the muscle's insertion.

Muscle Pain

Pain, soreness, or aching in one or more muscles caused by exertion, injury, infection, inflammation, medicines, or an underlying medical condition. Persistent, severe, or weakness-associated pain needs assessment.

Alternate Names:
Myalgia; Muscle Ache; Myodynia

Muscle Protein

A protein found in muscle that provides structure, produces contraction, stores or transports substances, or regulates muscle activity. Important examples include actin, myosin, troponin, dystrophin, and myoglobin.

Muscle Relaxant

A medicine that reduces skeletal-muscle spasms or tightness. Some act in the brain or spinal cord and may cause sleepiness or weakness. Neuromuscular-blocking medicines are a distinct group that temporarily paralyzes muscles and requires breathing support and close monitoring.

Muscle Relaxants

See *Muscle Relaxant*.

Muscle Relaxation

The return of a muscle to a less tense state after contraction, when calcium levels inside the muscle cell fall and the contractile proteins stop generating force.

Muscle Rigidity

Muscle rigidity is abnormal resistance to passive movement caused by sustained muscle contraction or altered tone. It occurs in conditions such as Parkinson disease, dystonia, meningitis, neuroleptic malignant syndrome, and tetanus.

Muscle Spasm

An involuntary, abrupt, sustained, and often painful contraction of a muscle or group of muscle fibers that cannot be consciously relaxed. Pathophysiologically, spasms arise from peripheral motor nerve hyperactivity, neuromuscular fatigue, ischemia, metabolic or electrolyte derangements (hypokalemia, hypocalcemia [producing tetany via increased peripheral nerve excitability], hypomagnesemia, and hyponatremia), or dehydration, as well as protective reflex muscle splinting secondary to acute musculoskeletal trauma, facet joint injury, or lumbar intervertebral disc herniation. Differentiated from muscular cramps (transient, self-limited painful spasms, commonly in calf muscles) and spasticity (velocity-dependent resistance to passive stretch arising from upper motor neuron lesions). Management involves passive stretching, massage, local heat or cold application, electrolyte repletion, nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs), and short-term centrally acting skeletal muscle relaxants (e.g., cyclobenzaprine, baclofen, tizanidine).

Muscle Spasms

Plural form; see *Muscle Spasm*.

Muscle Spindle

A small sensor inside skeletal muscle that detects how much the muscle is stretched and how quickly it changes length. It helps maintain posture, muscle tone, balance, and coordinated movement.

Muscle Strain Treatment

Care for a stretched or torn muscle, usually involving temporary activity reduction, gradual movement, rehabilitation, and pain relief chosen safely for the person. Severe swelling, weakness, deformity, inability to use the limb, or persistent pain needs assessment.

Muscle Strength

Muscle strength is the maximal force a muscle or muscle group can generate under specified conditions. It is assessed by functional or resisted testing and may be reduced by muscle, nerve, neuromuscular-junction, central, or systemic disorders.

Muscle-Tendon Unit

The connected working unit made of a muscle and its tendon. It produces force and transfers that force to a bone or other structure.

Muscle Tissue

Specialized tissue that contracts to produce movement, maintain posture, move substances through organs, and generate heat. Skeletal, heart, and smooth muscle have different structures and control systems for their jobs.

Muscle Tone

The slight, continuous activity present in resting muscles that gives them some resistance to being stretched. Abnormally high or low muscle tone can occur with disorders of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, or muscles.

Muscle Tonus

The slight, continuous activity present in resting muscles, which gives them resistance to being stretched. Too much or too little tone can occur with disorders of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, or muscles.

Muscle Twitching

Brief involuntary contractions of a small group of muscle fibers, often called fasciculations; persistent or widespread twitching may require evaluation.

Muscle Weakness

Reduced ability to generate force with one or more muscles. Causes include nerve or muscle disease, pain, inactivity, medicines, metabolic disorders, and aging.

Muscular

Relating to muscle or made of muscle tissue. It may describe strength, body build, pain, weakness, or a structure containing muscle.

Muscular Dystrophies

Alternate plural form; see *Muscular Dystrophy*.

Muscular Dystrophy

An umbrella term for genetic disorders that cause progressive weakness and degeneration of skeletal muscle. The disorders differ in the genes and proteins involved, inheritance pattern, age of onset, distribution and rate of muscle involvement, and severity; some result from new genetic changes without a family history. Depending on the type, disease may also affect heart muscle, breathing, swallowing, vision, endocrine function, or cognition. Common forms include Duchenne, Becker, limb-girdle, facioscapulohumeral, congenital, and myotonic muscular dystrophies.

Alternate Names:
MD

Muscular Endurance

The ability of a muscle or muscle group to keep working during repeated or prolonged effort. It depends on muscle strength, energy supply, blood flow, nerve control, conditioning, and overall health.

Muscularis

A layer of smooth muscle in the wall of a hollow organ, especially the digestive tract. Its coordinated contractions move contents through the organ and can also change the diameter or pressure of the passage.

Alternate Names:
Muscular Layer; Tunica Muscularis

Muscular System

The body system made up mainly of skeletal, smooth, and heart muscle. It produces movement, maintains posture, moves substances through organs, pumps blood, and generates heat.

Musculocutaneous Nerve

A nerve from the neck and upper chest that controls several muscles used to bend the elbow and turn the forearm. It also carries sensation from part of the outer forearm; injury can cause weakness or numbness there.

Musculoskeletal

Relating to muscles, bones, joints, tendons, ligaments, and related tissues.

Musculoskeletal Deformity

A musculoskeletal deformity is an abnormal shape, alignment, or structure of bone, joint, muscle, or related tissue. It may be congenital, developmental, traumatic, degenerative, neuromuscular, or caused by disease.

Musculoskeletal Disease

A disorder affecting bones, joints, muscles, tendons, ligaments, cartilage, or other supporting tissues,

causing pain or limited movement.

Musculoskeletal Injury

Trauma to muscles, bones, joints, tendons, ligaments, cartilage, or related soft tissues, ranging from strains and sprains to fractures and dislocations.

Musculoskeletal Pain

Pain arising from muscles, bones, joints, ligaments, tendons, or related soft tissues. Common causes include injury, overuse, arthritis, and inflammation; persistent pain, weakness, swelling, or neurologic symptoms should be assessed.

Musculoskeletal System

The musculoskeletal system consists of bones, joints, cartilage, ligaments, tendons, muscles, and associated connective tissues. It provides support, protects organs, enables movement, and contributes to mineral storage and blood-cell production.

Musculoskeletal Tumor

An abnormal growth arising in bone, muscle, cartilage, connective tissue, or related structures. It may be benign or malignant and can cause a lump, pain, swelling, reduced function, or fracture.

Musculus

The Latin word for muscle, used in formal anatomical names. For example, "musculus deltoideus" means the deltoid muscle. Abbreviations may be used in anatomy texts to identify one or several muscles.

MUSE

A medicated urethral system that delivers a pellet into the urethra to treat erectile dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Medicated Urethral System for Erection

Mushroom

The visible fruiting body of a fungus. Edible mushrooms can provide nutrients, but wild mushrooms may be poisonous or resemble edible species.

Mushroom Poisoning

Illness caused by eating toxic fungi, with effects ranging from gastrointestinal upset to liver failure, neurologic toxicity, or death.

Mushroom Toxicity

Poisoning from an edible-looking or otherwise toxic mushroom, with syndromes ranging from early gastrointestinal illness or hallucinations to delayed hepatic or renal failure. The species, amount, and time to symptoms influence the toxicity pattern and treatment.

Music Therapy

The planned use of music by a trained therapist to support health and wellbeing. It may help with pain, stress, communication, movement, memory, emotional expression, or coping during illness and rehabilitation.

MuSK-Positive Myasthenia Gravis

A form of myasthenia gravis in which antibodies interfere with nerve-to-muscle communication. It often causes weakness of the face, mouth, throat, neck, or breathing muscles and requires specialist care.

Alternate Names:
MuSK Myasthenia Gravis; MuSK-Ab-Positive MG

Mustard Compounds

Mustard compounds are chemical agents containing reactive sulfur or nitrogen mustard groups that can alkylate DNA and other molecules. Some are chemotherapy drugs; others are highly toxic chemical-warfare agents.

Mustard Gas

Mustard gas, or sulfur mustard, is a vesicant chemical-warfare agent that damages skin, eyes, and respiratory tissues and can cause blistering, airway injury, and delayed complications. It is not a true gas at ordinary temperatures and has no specific widely available antidote.

Mutagen

A chemical, physical agent, or biological factor capable of causing a genetic mutation. Mutagenicity does not by itself prove that an agent causes cancer.

Mutant

A mutant is a cell, organism, or genetic sequence carrying a mutation relative to a reference or parental form. The change may have no effect, alter a trait, or cause disease, depending on its location and functional consequence.

Mutant Proteins

Proteins whose amino-acid sequence differs because of a genetic mutation. The change may have no effect or may alter folding, stability, location, or function and contribute to inherited disease, cancer, or drug resistance.

Mutate

To mutate means to undergo a change in genetic sequence. Mutations arise spontaneously or from replication errors, DNA damage, or mutagen exposure and may be inherited, acquired in somatic cells, harmful, neutral, or beneficial.

Mutation

A heritable or acquired alteration in the DNA sequence. Variants may be single-nucleotide substitutions, insertions, deletions, copy-number changes, or larger rearrangements and may be benign, pathogenic, or of uncertain significance.

Mutation Abnormality

A mutation abnormality is an atypical change in DNA sequence or chromosome structure identified relative to a reference. Its clinical significance must be classified using evidence, such as pathogenic, likely pathogenic, uncertain significance, likely benign, or benign.

Mutation Rate

The frequency at which new DNA changes arise in a cell, organism, or generation. The rate differs between genes and species and can be influenced by DNA-copying errors, repair systems, radiation, chemicals, or other factors.

Mute

Describing a person who does not speak, whether because of a physical, neurologic, developmental, or psychological reason or by choice; more specific terms identify the communication limitation or preference.

Mutism

Absence or near absence of spoken language in a person who has the physical ability to speak. It may occur with neurologic or developmental conditions, catatonia, or selective mutism, an anxiety disorder in which a person consistently does not speak in certain settings despite speaking in others.

Myalgia

Muscle pain or aching. It may affect one area after injury or exercise, or be widespread with infection, inflammation, medicine effects, thyroid disease, or other conditions. Severe or unexplained muscle pain, weakness, or swelling, especially with dark urine, can signal rhabdomyolysis.

Alternate Names:
Myodynia; Muscle Pain

Myalgic Encephalomyelitis

A complex illness involving substantial activity-limiting fatigue, post-exertional worsening, unrefreshing sleep, and often cognitive or orthostatic symptoms.

Alternate Names:
ME/CFS; SEID; Systemic Exertional Intolerance Disease

Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome

A complex illness characterized by substantial reduction in activity, post-exertional malaise, unrefreshing sleep, and cognitive or autonomic symptoms. Management is individualized and focuses on pacing, symptom relief, and treatment of coexisting conditions.

Myasthenia

Muscle weakness. The term is sometimes used as a short name for myasthenia gravis, an autoimmune disease in which weakness often worsens with activity and improves with rest.

Myasthenia Crisis

A life-threatening exacerbation of myasthenia gravis in which worsening weakness causes respiratory failure requiring ventilatory support, either noninvasive ventilation or intubation. Severe weakness of the throat and other bulbar muscles may accompany respiratory weakness or, in some cases, predominate. Infection, surgery, or changes in medication can precipitate an episode.

Myasthenia Gravis

A chronic autoimmune disorder in which the immune system produces antibodies that block or destroy communication receptors between nerves and voluntary muscles. This prevents muscles from receiving signals properly, leading to fluctuating muscle weakness that worsens with repetitive physical activity and improves with rest. It commonly affects the muscles that control eyelid movement, facial expression, chewing, speaking, and swallowing.

Myasthenia Gravis and Pregnancy

Pregnancy and the postpartum period can alter autoimmune neuromuscular weakness, while some medicines and anesthesia may worsen respiratory or swallowing function. Neurology and obstetric planning addresses medication safety, delivery, neonatal weakness, and crisis risk.

Myasthenic Crisis

A life-threatening worsening of myasthenia gravis that weakens the muscles needed for breathing or swallowing. Infection, surgery, stress, pregnancy, or certain medicines may trigger it. Severe breathlessness, choking, inability to swallow, or rapidly worsening weakness may occur.

Alternate Names:
Myasthenia Gravis Crisis; Acute Myasthenic Exacerbation

Myasthenic Syndrome

A collective term for disorders that impair signaling at the neuromuscular junction and cause fatigable muscle weakness. The group includes autoimmune myasthenia gravis, Lambert-Eaton myasthenic syndrome, and inherited congenital myasthenic syndromes; the specific diagnosis should be named because these disorders have different causes.

Mycelium

The network of fine branching threads that makes up the growing part of a fungus. It spreads through soil, food, or tissue and can produce the structures that form fungal spores.

Mycetoma

A chronic infection of the skin and tissue beneath it, usually beginning when fungi (eumycetoma) or filamentous bacteria (actinomycetoma) enter through a puncture wound. It typically causes a painless lump, draining sinus tracts, and discharge containing small grains of the causative organism; it can spread into deeper tissues and bone.

Mycobacteriaceae

A family of slow-growing or rapidly growing, acid-fast bacteria that includes Mycobacterium species causing tuberculosis, leprosy, and nontuberculous infections.

Mycobacterial Culture

A laboratory test that tries to grow Mycobacterium bacteria from a sample such as sputum, tissue, or fluid. It can identify tuberculosis or other mycobacteria and may show which medicines will work, but results can take weeks.

Mycobacterial Infection

Infection caused by bacteria in the genus Mycobacterium. It includes tuberculosis, leprosy, and nontuberculous mycobacterial disease; symptoms and treatment depend on the species and affected organs.

Mycobacterium

A genus of acid-fast bacteria that includes the causes

of tuberculosis and leprosy and several nontuberculous infections.

Mycobacterium Abscessus

A rapidly growing nontuberculous mycobacterium that can cause pulmonary, skin, and soft-tissue infections and is often difficult to treat because of multidrug resistance.

Mycobacterium Avium

A member of the Mycobacterium avium complex that can cause lung disease, lymph-node infection, or disseminated infection, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Mycobacterium Avium Complex

A group of nontuberculous mycobacteria that can cause chronic pulmonary disease or disseminated infection, particularly in people with impaired immunity. Treatment depends on the species, site, severity, susceptibility, and patient factors.

Mycobacterium Bovis

A tuberculosis-complex bacterium that mainly infects cattle but can cause tuberculosis in humans through unpasteurized dairy or animal exposure.

Mycobacterium Chelonae

A rapidly growing nontuberculous mycobacterium that can cause skin, soft-tissue, bone, eye, or disseminated infection.

Mycobacterium Fortuitum

A rapidly growing nontuberculous mycobacterium that can cause wound, catheter, bone, lung, or other opportunistic infections.

Mycobacterium Gordonae

A usually nonpathogenic water-associated nontuberculous mycobacterium that can occasionally cause disease in people with weakened immunity.

Mycobacterium Haemophilum

A nontuberculous mycobacterium that can cause skin, joint, and bone infections, especially in people with impaired immunity.

Mycobacterium Infection

Infection caused by a Mycobacterium species, including tuberculosis, leprosy, and nontuberculous mycobacterial disease.

Mycobacterium Kansasii

A nontuberculous mycobacterium that commonly causes chronic lung disease resembling tuberculosis and can occasionally cause disseminated infection.

Mycobacterium Leprae

The bacterium that causes leprosy, a long-lasting infection affecting the skin and nerves. It usually spreads only after prolonged close contact, develops slowly, and can cause numbness, weakness, or skin lesions without treatment.

Mycobacterium Marinum

A nontuberculous mycobacterium associated with fish tanks and aquatic exposure that can cause chronic skin and soft-tissue infection.

Mycobacterium Scrofulaceum

A nontuberculous mycobacterium associated especially with cervical lymph-node infection in children and occasional other disease.

Mycobacterium Szulgai

A rare nontuberculous bacterium that can cause long-lasting lung disease or other infections, especially in people with underlying lung problems or weakened immunity. Diagnosis requires specialist laboratory testing and clinical assessment.

Mycobacterium Tuberculosis

An acid-fast bacterium in the *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* complex and the most common cause of tuberculosis in humans. It is transmitted in airborne particles released by people with infectious pulmonary or laryngeal disease. Infection most often involves the lungs but may affect other organs.

Alternate Names:
Mtb Tubercle bacillus

Mycobacterium Ulcerans

A mycobacterium that causes Buruli ulcer, a chronic destructive skin infection associated with the toxin mycolactone.

Mycology

The branch of microbiology that studies fungi, including yeasts, moulds, and mushrooms. Medical mycology focuses on fungal pathogens that cause disease in humans. Fungal infections (mycoses) are classified as superficial, cutaneous, subcutaneous, or systemic.

Mycophenolate Mofetil

Mycophenolate mofetil is a prodrug of mycophenolic acid that inhibits inosine monophosphate dehydrogenase and lymphocyte proliferation. It is used as an immunosuppressant, especially after organ transplantation, and can cause infection, cytopenias, gastrointestinal effects, and serious fetal harm.

Mycophenolic Acid

The active immune-suppressing substance formed from mycophenolate medicines. It blocks an enzyme needed by multiplying lymphocytes and helps prevent organ-transplant rejection, but can cause infections, low blood counts, diarrhea, and fetal harm.

Mycoplasma

A genus of very small bacteria lacking a cell wall, including organisms that cause respiratory and genitourinary infections.

Mycoplasma Genitalium

A sexually transmitted bacterium that can cause urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, and, less commonly, proctitis. Many infections are asymptomatic. Diagnosis is usually by a nucleic acid amplification test; macrolide resistance is common, and treatment varies with susceptibility.

Mycoplasma Genitalium Infection

Infection of the genital or urinary tract caused by Mycoplasma genitalium. It may cause urethritis, cervicitis, pelvic inflammatory disease, or proctitis, but many infections are asymptomatic; it is diagnosed with nucleic acid amplification testing.

Mycoplasma Hominis

A wall-less bacterium associated with the genital tract that can cause pelvic, postpartum, urinary, wound, or joint infection.

Mycoplasmal Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by Mycoplasma species, most often Mycoplasma pneumoniae, usually producing a gradual cough and fever.

Mycoplasma Pneumonia

Atypical pneumonia most common in ages 5–35. Dry cough, low-grade fever, headache. Patchy infiltrates on CXR disproportionate to symptoms ("walking pneumonia").

Mycoplasma Pneumoniae

A bacterium without a cell wall that can cause bronchitis, sore throat, or pneumonia, especially in school-age children and young adults. Illness often develops gradually with cough, fever, headache, or tiredness; complications outside the lungs are uncommon but possible.

Mycoplasma Pneumoniae-Associated Mucositis

Inflammation and sores affecting the mouth, eyes, or genitals during or after *Mycoplasma pneumoniae* infection. Skin lesions may be absent or limited; the term reactive infectious mucocutaneous eruption (RIME) is also used for similar illness associated with other infections.

Mycoplasmataceae

A family of very small bacteria that lack a cell wall and includes Mycoplasma and related genera.

Mycosis

An infection caused by a fungus, including a yeast or mold. Mycoses may be superficial, cutaneous, subcutaneous, or systemic, depending on the tissues involved; the site and organism determine symptoms

and treatment.

Mycosis Fungoides

The most common cutaneous T-cell lymphoma, presenting with progressive patches, plaques, and tumors on the skin with an indolent course. Staging and therapy depend on skin involvement and extracutaneous spread.

Alternate Names:
MF

Mycosis Fungoides Lymphoma

Alternate name; see *Mycosis Fungoides*.

Mycotic Aneurysm

An infected arterial wall or aneurysm, usually caused by bacteria rather than fungi. It may develop from bloodstream infection or an infected embolus and can rupture, causing life-threatening hemorrhage.

Mycotoxin

A poisonous substance made by some fungi that can contaminate food, crops, or indoor environments. Exposure may damage the liver, kidneys, nervous system, immune system, or other organs depending on the toxin and dose.

Mydriasis

Dilation of the pupil, produced mainly by sympathetic activity through the dilator pupillae muscle or by reduced parasympathetic activity. Causes include darkness, medicines, toxins, neurologic disease, and ocular injury.

Mydriatic Agents

A medicine that widens the pupil. Some, such as tropicamide or atropine, also temporarily prevent focusing; others, such as phenylephrine, mainly widen the pupil. These medicines are used to examine the inside of the eye and sometimes to ease pain and prevent scarring during eye inflammation. They can trigger a dangerous rise in eye pressure in people with narrow drainage angles.

Myelin

Myelin is an insulating sheath around nerve fibers that speeds electrical conduction; it is produced by oligodendrocytes in the CNS and Schwann cells in the PNS.

Myelination

Myelination is formation of a myelin sheath around an axon by oligodendrocytes in the central nervous system or Schwann cells in the peripheral nervous system. It increases the speed and efficiency of nerve conduction.

Myelin Sheath

Alternate name; see *Myelin*.

Myelitis

Myelitis is inflammation of the spinal cord or, less commonly, other neural tissue described by the term. Transverse myelitis can cause weakness, sensory changes, and bladder or bowel dysfunction and may result from infection, immune disease, reduced blood flow, or pressure on the spinal cord.

Myeloablative Agonist

A nonstandard expression that most likely means *myeloablative agent*, a drug or treatment that severely or completely destroys blood-forming cells in the bone marrow. Myeloablative therapy may be used before a stem-cell transplant and causes profound, temporary low blood counts; “agonist” is not the usual term in this context.

Myeloablative Chemotherapy

Myeloablative chemotherapy destroys or severely suppresses bone-marrow blood-cell production and is often used before a stem-cell transplant.

Myeloblast

An immature precursor of granulocytes in the bone marrow; excess myeloblasts are characteristic of acute myeloid leukemia.

Myelocyte

A developing granulocyte precursor in bone marrow

that is more mature than a myeloblast and normally absent or rare in peripheral blood.

Myelocytic Leukaemia

A blood cancer arising from cells that normally develop into several blood-cell types. It includes acute and chronic myeloid forms, which can cause anemia, infections, bleeding, fatigue, or an enlarged spleen.

Myelodysplastic Neoplasms

A group of clonal bone-marrow disorders in which blood cells develop abnormally and are made ineffectively. They can cause low red-cell, white-cell, or platelet counts, leading to anemia, infection, or bleeding; some types can progress to acute myeloid leukemia. They are also widely known as myelodysplastic syndromes (MDS).

Myelodysplastic Or Myeloproliferative Neoplasms

Myelodysplastic and myeloproliferative neoplasms are clonal bone-marrow disorders causing abnormal blood-cell production. They may produce anemia, infection, bleeding, high counts, enlarged spleen, thrombosis, or progression to acute leukemia; classification and mutation testing guide care.

Myelodysplastic Syndrome

See *Myelodysplastic Neoplasms*.

Myelodysplastic Syndrome (MDS)

Alternate name; see *Myelodysplastic Neoplasms*.

Myelodysplastic Syndromes

See *Myelodysplastic Neoplasms*.

Myeloencephalitis

Myeloencephalitis is inflammation involving the spinal cord and brain, caused by infection, immune disease, toxins, or other neurologic processes.

Myelofibrosis

A group of bone-marrow disorders in which fibrous tissue disrupts normal blood-cell production. It includes primary myelofibrosis and secondary forms caused by other blood or marrow diseases.

Myelogenous

Relating to blood-forming cells that develop from the bone marrow's myeloid cell line.

Alternate Names:
Myeloid

Myelogram

An imaging study of the spinal canal performed after contrast material is introduced around the spinal cord.

Myelography

Contrast injected into subarachnoid space for spinal imaging. Used when MRI contraindicated. CT myelography more common now.

Myeloid

Relating to bone marrow or to the non-lymphoid blood-cell lineages derived from hematopoietic stem cells.

Myeloid Cell

A blood-forming cell from the myeloid lineage, which produces red cells, platelets, and several white blood-cell types.

Myeloid Leukemia

Myeloid leukemia is a blood cancer arising from abnormal myeloid precursor cells in the bone marrow and blood.

Myeloid Sarcoma

Myeloid sarcoma is a mass of immature myeloid cells occurring outside the bone marrow, often associated with acute myeloid leukemia.

Myelolipoma

A usually benign tumor composed of mature adipose tissue and blood-forming tissue, most often arising in the adrenal gland and often found incidentally.

Myeloma

A cancer of plasma cells, usually called multiple myeloma when it affects many bone-marrow sites. It can cause bone pain, anemia, kidney damage, high blood calcium, infections, or abnormal proteins in blood and urine.

Myeloma Cast Nephropathy

Kidney damage caused by abnormal proteins from multiple myeloma blocking and injuring the kidney's filtering tubes. It can cause sudden kidney failure and is treated by addressing the myeloma and supporting kidney function.

Myelomalacia

Softening of the spinal cord, usually due to ischemia, trauma, hemorrhage, or other cord injury.

Myelomeningocele

A congenital neural tube defect in which the spinal cord and its coverings protrude through an opening in the vertebral column, often within a sac. Unlike a meningocele, the protrusion includes spinal cord or nerve tissue, which may be damaged. This can cause weakness or paralysis, loss of sensation, and bladder or bowel dysfunction below the defect. Severity varies with its level and extent; hydrocephalus and Chiari II malformation may also occur. It is the most severe common form of spina bifida.

Myelomonocyte

A bone-marrow precursor that can develop toward either the monocyte or granulocyte lineages. An immature bone marrow cell that can develop into either monocytes or certain infection-fighting white blood cells.

Myelopathy

Disease or damage affecting the spinal cord and disrupting signals between the brain and body. Causes include pressure on the cord, injury, reduced blood flow, infection, inflammation, changes in the spine with age, or a tumor. Symptoms may include weakness or stiffness, numbness, trouble walking, pain, or changes in bowel or bladder function.

Myeloperoxidase

An enzyme in neutrophil and monocyte granules that uses hydrogen peroxide and chloride to generate antimicrobial oxidants; antibodies against it occur in some autoimmune diseases.

Myelopoiesis

The production and development of myeloid blood cells, including granulocytes, monocytes, and some precursor cells, in the bone marrow.

Myeloproliferative Disorders

Clonal bone-marrow cancers that cause overproduction of one or more blood-cell lineages. The classic Philadelphia chromosome-negative types are polycythemia vera, essential thrombocythemia, and primary myelofibrosis; chronic myeloid leukemia is another major myeloproliferative neoplasm.

Myeloproliferative Neoplasm

A group of cancers that begin in blood-forming cells in the bone marrow. They often cause overproduction of red blood cells, platelets, or certain white blood cells; in myelofibrosis, later scarring of the bone marrow can reduce blood-cell production. Major types include chronic myeloid leukemia, polycythemia vera, essential thrombocythemia, and primary myelofibrosis. Less common types include chronic neutrophilic and chronic eosinophilic leukemia. These disorders can cause blood clots or bleeding, and some can progress to acute leukemia.

Alternate Names:
Myeloproliferative Neoplasms; MPN; MPNs

Myelosuppression

Reduced bone marrow production of red cells, white cells, and platelets, causing anemia, neutropenia, and thrombocytopenia; a common dose-limiting toxicity of chemotherapy and radiation that increases infection and bleeding risk.

Myelosuppressive Therapy

Myelosuppressive therapy reduces bone-marrow production of blood cells, sometimes intentionally during cancer treatment but with risk of anemia, infection, and bleeding.

Myenteric Plexus

A network of enteric nerves between the circular and longitudinal muscle layers of the gastrointestinal tract that coordinates intestinal motility.

Myhre Syndrome

A rare inherited connective-tissue disorder caused by variants in SMAD4 and characterized by short stature, stiff joints, distinctive facial features, hearing loss, and cardiovascular abnormalities.

Myiasis

Infestation of living tissue by larvae (maggots) of various fly species, which feed on host tissue and can cause pain, secondary infection, and tissue destruction. It may be cutaneous, involving the skin and subcutaneous tissue, or affect other body sites including the nose, ears, and wounds.

Myoblast

An early muscle cell that develops and joins with others to form skeletal muscle fibers.

Myoblastoma

A rare tumor made of cells resembling developing muscle cells. The term has been used for more than one tumor type, so diagnosis requires modern microscopic and molecular classification.

Alternate Names:
Granular Cell Tumor; Abrikossoff Tumor

Myocardial

Relating to the myocardium, the muscular wall of the heart.

Myocardial Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of heart muscle, usually by catheter, for microscopic or molecular examination of suspected myocarditis, rejection, infiltrative disease, or other cardiomyopathy.

Myocardial Bridging

Myocardial bridging occurs when a segment of a coronary artery tunnels through heart muscle and may be compressed during contraction.

Myocardial Contusion

A bruise of the heart muscle caused by blunt chest trauma, which may produce chest pain, arrhythmias, or impaired heart function.

Myocardial Infarction

Commonly known as a heart attack, the damage or death of a segment of heart muscle caused by a sudden, prolonged disruption of blood flow and oxygen. It most frequently occurs when a blood clot forms over a ruptured fatty plaque inside a coronary artery, cutting off circulation. Classic symptoms include chest pressure or squeezing pain that may radiate to the left arm, neck, or jaw, along with shortness of breath, cold sweating, and nausea.

Alternate Names:
Heart Attack; MI; Acute Myocardial Infarction

Myocardial Ischemia

Reduced blood flow and oxygen supply to heart muscle, usually from narrowed coronary arteries, potentially causing chest pain or heart damage.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Ischemia

Myocardial Perfusion Imaging

A heart scan that compares blood flow to the heart muscle at rest and during exercise or medicine-induced stress. It can show areas with reduced blood supply or old heart-muscle damage.

Myocardial Reperfusion

Restoration of blood flow to heart muscle after ischemia, which can limit injury but may also cause reperfusion-related tissue damage.

Myocardial Rupture

A tear in the heart wall or other heart structure, usually a severe complication of myocardial infarction.

Myocardial Viability

The ability of heart muscle weakened by poor blood flow to recover if blood supply is restored. Imaging tests can show whether the tissue is still alive and

may help guide decisions about restoring blood flow.

Myocarditis

Inflammation of the heart muscle. It is often related to an infection or an abnormal immune response; some medicines (such as clozapine and some cancer medicines) and conditions (such as lupus, systemic sclerosis, and sarcoidosis) can also cause it. It may cause chest pain, shortness of breath, abnormal heart rhythms, or weakened pumping of the heart. Severity ranges from no symptoms or mild illness to heart failure or shock.

Myocarditis Diagnosis

Doctors assess suspected heart-muscle inflammation using symptoms, examination, an electrocardiogram, blood tests, heart imaging, and sometimes MRI or biopsy. No single test proves every case, so results are interpreted together and other causes are excluded.

Myocarditis Pathology

Inflammatory infiltrates with associated cardiomyocyte injury or necrosis that is not explained by ischemia. The pattern may be lymphocytic, eosinophilic, giant-cell, granulomatous, or mixed depending on the cause.

Myocarditis Treatment

Treatment depends on the cause and severity. Care may include rest from strenuous exercise, medicines for heart failure or abnormal rhythms, treatment of infection or autoimmune inflammation when appropriate, and hospital monitoring for severe cases.

Myocardium

The thick muscular middle layer of the heart wall that contracts to pump blood throughout the body.

Myoclonic Epilepsy

An epilepsy syndrome in which seizures include brief, shock-like involuntary muscle jerks; the specific syndrome determines associated seizure types, age of onset, and prognosis.

Myoclonic Seizure

A seizure involving one or more brief, shock-like, involuntary muscle jerks. Awareness is often preserved, but may be impaired depending on the seizure type. Jerks commonly affect the arms and can cause a person to drop or throw an object; they are characteristic of juvenile myoclonic epilepsy but occur in other disorders as well.

Myoclonus

A sudden, brief, involuntary muscle jerk or group of jerks.

Myocyte

A differentiated muscle cell specialized for contraction. Skeletal myocytes are long, multinucleated fibers; cardiac myocytes are branching cells joined by intercalated discs; and smooth-muscle myocytes are spindle-shaped cells without organized sarcomeres. Myocyte injury or death contributes to myopathy, rhabdomyolysis, and myocardial infarction.

Alternate Names:
Muscle Cell

Myodegeneration

Degeneration or breakdown of muscle fibers, caused by inherited, inflammatory, ischemic, toxic, or other disorders.

Myoepithelial Carcinoma Pathology

An infiltrative malignant neoplasm composed predominantly of myoepithelial cells, which may be clear, epithelioid, spindle, or plasmacytoid and show variable immunoreactivity for myoepithelial markers. It most often arises in salivary tissue or soft tissue.

Myoepithelial Cell

A contractile cell around certain glands that helps push secretions from breast or salivary tissue.

Myoepithelioma

A myoepithelioma is a tumor composed of myoepithelial cells and can be benign or malignant, commonly arising in salivary or other glands.

Myoepithelioma Of Soft Tissue

A rare growth in soft tissue made of myoepithelial cells, which have features of both gland cells and muscle-like support cells. It may be harmless or cancerous; imaging and tissue examination determine treatment.

Myoepithelium

A layer of contractile epithelial cells surrounding secretory units and small ducts in some glands, including the breast and salivary glands. It helps move secretions and supports gland structure; in breast pathology, its presence or loss can help distinguish in-situ from invasive lesions.

Myofascial Pain Syndrome

A regional pain disorder involving sensitive trigger points in muscle and fascia, with pain that may be referred to other areas and often worsens with pressure or movement.

Myofibril

A contractile thread-like structure inside a muscle fiber, composed of repeating sarcomeres containing actin and myosin.

Myofibrillar Myopathy

Myofibrillar myopathy is a group of inherited muscle disorders with abnormal protein aggregates and progressive skeletal-muscle weakness, sometimes involving heart or breathing muscles.

Myofibrils

Plural form; see *Myofibril*.

Myofibroblastoma

A benign mesenchymal tumor composed of myofibroblastic cells in collagenous or myxoid stroma, most often arising in the mammary or inguinal region but potentially occurring at other soft-tissue sites.

Myofibroblastoma Of The Breast

A rare benign stromal tumor composed of spindle-shaped myofibroblastic cells, usually occurring in older adults. It is typically a well-circumscribed painless mass and is diagnosed by histology with immunohistochemistry.

Myofibroblasts

Cells that combine features of fibroblasts and smooth muscle cells and help contract wounds and produce scar tissue.

Myofibromatosis

Myofibromatosis is a benign proliferation of myofibroblastic tumors, often in infants or children and involving skin, muscle, bone, or internal organs.

Myofilament

A contractile protein filament within a muscle fiber; actin and myosin myofilaments interact through cross-bridges to produce muscle contraction.

Myofilaments

Plural form; see *Myofilament*.

Alternate Names:
Contractile Filaments; Actin and Myosin Filaments

Myogenin

A muscle-specific transcription factor required for skeletal-muscle differentiation and used as an immunohistochemical marker in diagnosing some soft-tissue tumors.

Myoglobin

An oxygen-binding protein stored in skeletal and heart muscle. When muscle is injured, myoglobin can enter the blood and urine; large amounts may contribute to kidney damage and are interpreted with other tests.

Myoglobin Blood Test

A blood test measuring myoglobin released from injured skeletal or cardiac muscle; it rises early after muscle injury but is nonspecific and is not preferred over troponin for myocardial infarction.

Myoglobinuria

A condition in which muscle protein enters urine,

often after severe muscle injury or breakdown.

Myoglobin Urine Test

A urine test detecting myoglobin released during muscle breakdown, used in evaluating rhabdomyolysis; substantial myoglobinuria can contribute to acute kidney injury.

Myokymia

Involuntary, fine, continuous rippling contractions of muscle fibers, often seen around the eye but also associated with nerve hyperexcitability or neurologic disease.

Myoma

A usually benign tumor made of muscle tissue. The term often refers to a leiomyoma, especially a uterine fibroid, but myomas can arise from smooth or skeletal muscle in other sites.

Myomalacia

Softening and breakdown of muscle tissue, sometimes affecting heart muscle after serious injury or poor blood supply.

Myomectomy

Surgical removal of uterine fibroids while leaving the uterus in place. It may improve bleeding, pain, or pressure symptoms and can preserve the possibility of pregnancy, although risks and recurrence remain.

Myometrium

The thick muscle layer forming most of the uterus. It contracts during menstruation and labor, responds to hormones, and may develop conditions such as fibroids, adenomyosis, or abnormal thickening.

Myopathic Facies

A characteristic expressionless, mask-like facial appearance marked by drooping eyelids (ptosis), prominent facial muscle wasting, an inability to bury the eyelashes, and a transverse, tented upper lip (tapir mouth). It occurs due to weakness of the facial musculature in conditions such as facioscapulohumeral dystrophy and myotonic dystrophy.

Myopathy

A disorder of skeletal muscle that can cause weakness, pain, cramps, or stiffness. It may be inherited or acquired. Causes include inflammation, some medicines, infections, toxins, hormone disorders, and problems with muscle energy production.

Myopericytoma

A myopericytoma is a usually benign perivascular tumor composed of cells around small blood vessels, often occurring in skin or soft tissue.

Myopia

A refractive error in which light focuses in front of the retina, usually because the eyeball is too long or the eye focuses too strongly. Distant objects appear blurred while near objects are usually clearer. It can be corrected with glasses, contact lenses, or selected refractive procedures.

Alternate Names:
Short-Sightedness; Nearsightedness

Myosarcoma

A general term for a malignant tumor arising from muscle tissue. Specific types include leiomyosarcoma, which arises from smooth muscle, and rhabdomyosarcoma, which shows skeletal-muscle differentiation.

Myosin

A protein that uses energy to pull on actin, another muscle protein, and produce movement or force. It is important for contraction of skeletal, heart, and smooth muscle and also helps movement inside many other cells.

Myosin Atpase

The activity by which the muscle protein myosin breaks down ATP, the cell's energy source. This releases energy that lets myosin pull on actin and produce muscle contraction.

Myositis

Inflammation of muscle tissue caused by autoimmune disease, infection, medicines, or injury. It

may produce weakness, pain, swelling, or fatigue; evaluation often includes examination, blood tests, imaging, and sometimes muscle testing.

Myositis Ossificans

A noncancerous condition in which abnormal bone forms inside a muscle or soft tissue, most often following a severe blunt injury, deep bruise, or surgery, commonly in the thigh or upper arm. It causes a firm, painful lump and joint stiffness and may improve as the abnormal bone matures.

Alternate Names:
Traumatic Myositis Ossificans; Heterotopic Ossification of Muscle

Myotonia

Delayed relaxation of a muscle after voluntary contraction or stimulation, often caused by an inherited or acquired muscle-channel disorder.

Myotonia Congenita

An inherited skeletal-muscle channelopathy causing delayed relaxation after voluntary contraction. Stiffness often improves with repeated movement and may be accompanied by muscle hypertrophy; onset and severity vary between genetic forms.

Myotonia Fluctuans

A rare inherited muscle-channel disorder causing stiffness that varies from day to day or after activity. It is usually mild and does not cause lasting weakness; genetic testing may identify a change in the *SCN4A* gene.

Alternate Names:
Potassium-Aggravated Myotonia Fluctuans

Myotonia Permanens

A rare inherited muscle-channel disorder causing continuous, severe muscle stiffness, including at rest. It may begin in infancy and affect the face, throat, or breathing muscles; it is usually related to a change in the *SCN4A* gene and requires specialist care.

Alternate Names:
Severe Sodium Channel Myotonia; Continuous Myotonia

Myotonic Disorder

A neuromuscular disorder characterized by delayed relaxation after muscle contraction, often with weakness, stiffness, or progressive muscle wasting.

Myotonic Dystrophy

An inherited disorder causing delayed muscle relaxation, progressive weakness, and wasting. It can also affect the heart, breathing, swallowing, eyes, hormones, or thinking; symptoms and severity vary between types and people.

Myotonic Dystrophy Type 2

An inherited multisystem disorder caused by CCTG repeat expansion in CNBP, producing myotonia, proximal or axial weakness, muscle pain, cataracts, and variable endocrine or cardiac features.

Myringitis

Inflammation of the eardrum that may cause ear pain, blisters, drainage, or temporary hearing changes.

Myringotomy

A small opening made in the eardrum to drain fluid or relieve pressure in the middle ear. A ventilation tube may be inserted to keep the opening open temporarily. Possible problems include infection, scarring, persistent drainage, or a hole that does not close.

Myringotomy With Tympanostomy Tube

Incision of the tympanic membrane with placement of a ventilation tube to equalize middle-ear pressure and permit drainage. It is used selectively for persistent middle-ear effusion, recurrent acute otitis media, or associated hearing and developmental problems.

Myristica Oil Poisoning

Poisoning from concentrated nutmeg oil, which can cause nausea, vomiting, agitation, fast heartbeat, dizziness, hallucinations, confusion, seizures, or coma. Suspected ingestion needs prompt poison-control or emergency assessment.

Myxedema

Severe hypothyroidism causing accumulation of mucin in tissues, with swelling, slowed body functions, and other symptoms.

Myxedema Coma

A life-threatening emergency caused by severe, untreated or undertreated hypothyroidism. It can cause very low body temperature, confusion or coma, a slow heartbeat, low blood pressure, and slow or shallow breathing. Infection, cold exposure, heart attack, stroke, or sedating medicines may trigger it.

Alternate Names:
Myxoedema Coma; Myxedematous Coma

Myxofibroma

A myxofibroma is a benign tumor containing fibrous and gelatinous myxoid tissue, often arising in the jaw or other connective tissue.

Myxofibrosarcoma

A rare cancer of connective tissue, usually in or under the skin of the arms or legs. It is more common in older adults and can return after treatment.

Myxoid Cyst

A myxoid cyst is a gelatinous fluid-filled lesion near a joint or tendon, commonly on a finger near the distal joint and nail.

Myxoma

A usually noncancerous tumor, most often in the upper left chamber of the heart. It may obstruct blood flow or release clots, causing breathlessness, fainting, fever, or stroke-like symptoms; heart ultrasound is commonly used for diagnosis.

Myxomatous Degeneration

Degenerative weakening and excessive myxoid tissue in a heart-valve leaflet, commonly associated with mitral-valve prolapse and possible valve regurgitation.

Myxopapillary Ependymoma

Myxopapillary ependymoma is a usually slow-growing spinal tumor arising from ependymal cells, commonly in the conus or filum terminale.

Myxosarcoma

A rare cancer of soft tissue containing abundant jelly-like material. It can grow into nearby tissue or spread to distant organs; diagnosis requires examination of a tissue sample.

MZL

Abbreviation; see *Marginal Zone Lymphoma*.

N

Nabothian Cyst

A small, harmless mucus-filled lump on the cervix caused by a blocked cervical gland. It is common and usually causes no symptoms or need for treatment; unusual or bleeding lesions may have other causes.

Nabumetone

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and inflammation in selected joint or muscle conditions. It can irritate the stomach, affect kidneys, raise cardiovascular risk, or cause allergic reactions, especially with prolonged use.

N-Acetylcysteine

An antidote used mainly for acetaminophen overdose. It helps protect the liver and may still help when treatment starts late or liver injury has already begun.

N-Acetylglutamate Synthetase Deficiency

An inherited urea-cycle disorder in which deficient N-acetylglutamate synthetase fails to activate carbamoyl phosphate synthetase I. Ammonia can accumulate and cause vomiting, sleepiness, confusion, seizures, coma, or developmental injury.

Nadir

The lowest level reached by a measurement or symptom. After chemotherapy, it often means the period when blood-cell counts are lowest and the risk of infection or bleeding is greatest.

Naegele Rule

A method for estimating the expected date of delivery by adding 280 days (40 weeks) to the first day of the last menstrual period, assuming a 28-day cycle with ovulation near day 14. It is less accurate when cycle length or menstrual dates are uncertain; ultrasound dating may revise the estimate.

Naegeli-Franceschetti-Jadassohn Syndrome

A rare inherited ectodermal disorder causing reticulate skin pigmentation, reduced sweating, abnormal teeth or nails, and sometimes loss of fingerprints. Associated features include heat intolerance and dental abnormalities.

Naegleria Fowleri

A free-living microscopic amoeba found mainly in warm freshwater lakes, rivers, and hot springs. If water containing it enters the nose, the amoeba can travel to the brain and cause primary amebic meningoencephalitis (PAM), a rare, rapidly worsening brain infection that is nearly always fatal. Early symptoms may include headache, fever, nausea, or vomiting, followed by stiff neck, confusion, seizures, or coma. Infection does not occur from swallowing the water and does not spread from person to person.

Naegleria Infection

Alternate name; see *Primary Amebic Meningoencephalitis*.

Naevus

The British spelling of nevus, a usually benign localized skin or mucosal lesion such as a mole.

Naevus Flammeus

A congenital vascular capillary malformation (port-wine stain) presenting as a flat, sharply demarcated, pink-to-violaceous cutaneous patch that does not regress spontaneously, classically involving the ophthalmic (V1) distribution of the trigeminal nerve in Sturge-Weber syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Port-Wine Stain; Capillary Vascular Malformation

Naffziger Sign

A historical test in which pressure on the neck veins was used to try to reproduce radiating nerve pain by raising pressure around the spinal cord. It is not a reliable test and is not part of routine modern evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Naffziger's Sign; Jugular Compression Radiculopathy Test

Nail

A hard protective plate on the end of each finger and toe. Nails protect the tips, help with fine tasks, and may show changes caused by injury, infection, skin disease, or illness elsewhere.

Nail Abnormalities

Changes in nail color, shape, thickness, texture, or attachment caused by trauma, infection, inflammatory disease, systemic illness, medication, or congenital conditions.

Nail Avulsion

Partial or complete separation of the nail plate from the nail bed, usually after injury. The term can also mean deliberate removal of part or all of the nail plate during a procedure. The nail bed or matrix may be injured at the same time.

Nail Bed Injury

Trauma to the tissue beneath a nail that may cause bleeding under the nail, laceration, nail separation, fracture of the fingertip, or permanent nail deformity. Severe disruption or fingertip crushing can damage the nail matrix or bone.

Nail Bed Laceration

A cut or tear in the skin beneath the nail plate, often caused by a crush or sharp injury. It may bleed or cause pain and can occur with a fingertip fracture or damage to the nail matrix. Healing injury can affect the shape of the new nail.

Nail-Biting

Repetitive biting of the fingernails or surrounding skin, often associated with stress, habit, or a body-focused repetitive behavior. It can damage the nail, skin, teeth, or jaw and may introduce infection.

Nail Changes

Alterations in nail color, shape, texture, or attachment that may result from local injury, skin disease, infection, medicines, nutritional deficiency, or systemic illness. Their significance depends on the pattern and other clinical findings.

Nail Clipping For Fungal Testing

Laboratory examination of clipped nail material by microscopy, culture, or another validated test for fungal infection. Testing can help distinguish nail fungus from injury, psoriasis, or other nail disorders, especially before oral antifungal treatment.

Nail Clubbing

Enlargement and rounding of the ends of the fingers or toes with more curved nails. It may run in families or signal disease of the lungs, heart, digestive system, or another organ, especially when it develops recently.

Nail Eczema

Eczema affecting the skin around the nail, especially the nail folds and cuticle. It can cause itching, redness, scaling, or cracks, and ongoing inflammation may produce ridges or other nail changes. Irritants, allergies, or atopic eczema may be involved.

Nail-Fold Capillaroscopy

A test that uses magnification to examine the tiny blood vessels near the nails. It can help distinguish primary Raynaud phenomenon from Raynaud phenomenon linked to conditions such as systemic scle-

rosis, dermatomyositis, or mixed connective-tissue disease.

Alternate Names:
Periungual Capillaroscopy; NFC Examination

Nail Fungus

A fungal infection of a fingernail or toenail, usually involving the nail plate or nail bed, that can cause thickening, discoloration, brittleness, distortion, or separation from the nail bed. The medical term is onychomycosis. Similar nail changes can result from psoriasis, trauma, or other disorders.

Alternate Names:
Onychomycosis

Nail Furrows

Nail furrows are grooves or depressions running across or along a nail; transverse Beau lines can follow systemic illness or trauma, while longitudinal ridges are often age-related but may reflect local or systemic disease.

Nail Infection

Infection of the nail or surrounding tissue, commonly caused by fungi or bacteria. It may cause thickening, discoloration, separation of the nail, pain, swelling, or drainage; diabetes and poor circulation increase the risk of complications.

Nail Injuries

Trauma to the nail plate, nail bed, nail folds, or fingertip that may cause bruising, laceration, avulsion, fracture, or later nail-growth abnormalities.

Nail Lichen Planus

Lichen planus affecting the nail matrix or nail bed can cause thinning, longitudinal ridges or splitting, and sometimes permanent nail deformity or loss. A dorsal pterygium, in which scar tissue grows from the proximal nail fold onto the nail, is a characteristic severe change.

Nail Patella Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Nail-Patella Syndrome*.

Nail-Patella Syndrome

A rare inherited condition that can affect the nails, kneecaps, elbows, and pelvis. Some people also develop kidney disease or glaucoma. It is usually caused by a change in the *LMX1B* gene.

Nail Pits

Small dents in the surface of a nail. They are common in psoriasis but may also occur with hair-loss disorders, eczema, lichen planus, or other conditions affecting nail growth.

Nail Pitting

Alternate name; see *Nail Pits*.

Nail Matrix Injury

Damage to the nail matrix, the tissue at the nail base that makes the nail plate. It can result from a cut, crush, or procedure and may cause temporary or lasting changes in nail shape or growth, depending on how much the matrix is damaged.

Nail Psoriasis

Psoriasis affecting the nails can cause small pits, separation from the nail bed, yellow or red-brown patches, thickening, crumbling, or ridges. It may occur with skin psoriasis or psoriatic arthritis and can be severe or newly developed.

Nails

Hard plates of keratin covering the ends of fingers and toes. Changes in color, shape, thickness, or attachment can result from injury, infection, skin disease, nutritional problems, or other illness.

Nail Surgery

A procedure on the nail plate, nail bed, nail fold, or matrix to treat ingrown nails, tumors, infection, trauma, or painful deformity. Risks include bleeding, infection, scarring, altered nail growth, and recurrence.

Nail Unit Basal Cell Carcinoma

A rare skin cancer arising in the nail unit, usually in skin beside or beneath the nail. It may look like a

persistent sore, swelling, or a damaged nail and can resemble infection or inflammation. It is a different cancer from nail-unit squamous cell carcinoma or melanoma.

Nail Unit Bowen Disease

Squamous cell carcinoma in situ of the nail unit, meaning abnormal cells remain in the surface layer and have not grown into deeper tissue. It may appear as a wart-like growth, scaling, a sore, or nail distortion and can be mistaken for infection.

Nail Unit Melanoma

A melanoma arising from pigment-producing cells in the nail unit, often in the nail matrix. It may cause a new brown or black lengthwise band, pigment on nearby skin, or nail splitting or damage; some tumors have little or no pigment.

Nail Unit Squamous Cell Carcinoma

A cancer arising from the surface cells of the nail unit. It often grows slowly and may look like a wart, a persistent sore, or a long-lasting nail infection. It can damage the nail and nearby tissue; Bowen disease is its in-situ form.

Nalbuphine

An opioid pain medicine with mixed effects, used for moderate to severe pain under medical supervision.

Naloxone

A medicine that blocks opioids and can quickly restore breathing during an opioid overdose. It comes as a nasal spray or injection. Emergency help is still needed because its effect may wear off before the opioid does.

Naltrexone

An opioid-receptor antagonist used in the treatment of opioid use disorder and alcohol use disorder. It blocks opioid effects and can reduce alcohol craving or heavy drinking. Because it can precipitate withdrawal in a person with recent opioid exposure, its use is limited to people who are no longer physically dependent on opioids.

Nanocolloid

Very small particles carrying a radioactive tracer. After injection, they can show how lymph drains and help locate the first lymph node receiving drainage from a tumor.

Nanomedicine

The use of very small materials or devices in medicine to help diagnose, prevent, monitor, or treat disease. Examples include nanoparticle drug carriers, imaging agents, biosensors, and some vaccine or cancer treatments; their effects and safety depend on the material, size, dose, and how the body handles them.

Nanoparticle

A particle with dimensions typically measured in nanometres. In medicine, nanoparticles may carry drugs, improve imaging, or support diagnostic tests; their safety depends on composition, size, dose, route, and how the body processes them.

Nanoscience

The study of materials and structures at approximately the nanometre scale, where surface and physical properties may differ from those of larger materials. It supports research in drug delivery, imaging, diagnostics, and biomaterials.

Nanotechnology

The design and use of materials, devices, or systems at the nanometre scale. Medical applications include targeted drug delivery, imaging agents, biosensors, tissue engineering, and diagnostic tests; safety depends on the specific material and exposure.

Napelline

A poisonous plant chemical related to aconite alkaloids. Exposure can disturb nerve signals and heart rhythm, causing tingling, weakness, vomiting, dangerous blood-pressure changes, or life-threatening cardiac poisoning.

Naphazoline

A topical alpha-adrenergic agonist used as a nasal decongestant or ocular vasoconstrictor; prolonged

use can worsen congestion.

Naphthalene Poisoning

Harm from mothballs or other products containing naphthalene. It can destroy red blood cells, causing weakness, jaundice, dark urine, kidney injury, seizures, or coma.

Nappy Rash

Alternate name; see *Diaper Rash*.

Naproxen

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID) used to relieve pain, fever, and inflammation. It inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes and reduces prostaglandin production. Important risks include stomach or intestinal ulcers and bleeding, kidney injury, fluid retention, and increased risk of heart attack or stroke, especially with higher doses or prolonged use.

Naproxen Sodium Overdose

Taking too much naproxen can cause stomach pain, vomiting, bleeding, drowsiness, kidney injury, seizures, or breathing problems. Large or intentional overdoses can be life-threatening.

Narcissism

A pattern of excessive self-focus, need for admiration, or sense of superiority. Mild traits are common, while persistent traits that impair relationships or functioning may occur in narcissistic personality disorder.

Narcissistic Personality Disorder

A pervasive pattern of grandiosity, need for admiration, and impaired empathy that begins by early adulthood and occurs across contexts. It causes significant difficulty in relationships or functioning. Diagnosis is based on established clinical criteria; narcissistic traits alone do not constitute the disorder.

Alternate Names:
NPD

Narcolepsy

A chronic disorder of sleep-wake regulation marked by excessive daytime sleepiness and, in some people, sudden sleep episodes. Other features can include disrupted nighttime sleep, sleep paralysis, vivid dream-like experiences at sleep onset or awakening, and cataplexy (brief emotion-triggered loss of muscle tone). Type 1 is associated with cataplexy and/or deficient hypocretin (orexin); type 2 occurs without cataplexy and without documented hypocretin deficiency.

Narcoleptic Syndrome

Alternate name for narcolepsy, a neurologic sleep disorder causing excessive daytime sleepiness and, in some people, cataplexy, sleep paralysis, or vivid hallucinations; see *Narcolepsy*.

NARP Syndrome

A rare inherited mitochondrial disorder that can cause nerve damage, muscle weakness, loss of coordination, seizures, and vision problems. Symptoms and severity vary widely.

Alternate Names:
NARP; Neuropathy, Ataxia, and Retinitis Pigmentosa

Narrow Angle Glaucoma

An older, imprecise term sometimes used for an anatomically narrow anterior chamber angle, which increases the risk of angle closure. A narrow angle is a risk state and is not itself synonymous with angle-closure glaucoma, which involves glaucomatous optic-nerve damage.

Narrowband UVB Phototherapy

Exposure to a narrow range of ultraviolet B light, centered near 311–313 nm, used for inflammatory and pigmentary skin disorders such as psoriasis, vitiligo, and eczema. The radiation suppresses cutaneous inflammation or alters pigment-cell activity; repeated exposure can cause erythema and cumulative skin damage.

Narrow-Complex Tachycardia

A fast heart rhythm with a QRS duration under

120 milliseconds on an electrocardiogram. It usually arises above the ventricles, though the rhythm's origin and cause require assessment; symptoms may include palpitations, dizziness, chest discomfort, breathlessness, or fainting.

Narrow Pulse Pressure

A pulse pressure—the difference between systolic and diastolic blood pressure—that is low relative to the systolic pressure. It is often defined as less than one-quarter of the systolic pressure, although thresholds vary by clinical setting. It can occur with reduced blood pumped by the heart, as in blood loss, cardiac tamponade, or severe heart failure.

Narrow Therapeutic Index

A medicine for which the helpful dose is close to the harmful dose. Small changes in dose or blood concentration can cause toxicity, and treatment commonly involves close dose or level monitoring.

Nasal

Relating to the nose or the space inside it. The nose warms, moistens, and filters incoming air and helps with smell and speech. Nasal disease may cause blockage, bleeding, discharge, reduced smell, or difficulty breathing.

Nasal Bleeding

Alternate name; see *Epistaxis*.

Nasal Cannula

A soft tube with two small prongs that rest inside the nostrils to deliver supplemental oxygen. The prescribed oxygen flow depends on the person's needs and is adjusted with monitoring.

Nasal Cavity

The paired space inside the nose, extending from the nostrils to the nasopharynx. It warms, humidifies, and filters inspired air and contains the receptors responsible for smell.

Nasal Congestion

A blocked or stuffy feeling in the nose caused by swelling of the nasal lining, extra mucus, or a structural problem. It occurs with colds, allergies, sinus disease, irritants, and other conditions.

Nasal Congestion And Rhinorrhea

Nasal obstruction or stuffiness together with a runny nose, commonly caused by viral infection, allergic or nonallergic rhinitis, sinus disease, irritants, or structural blockage. Persistent unilateral symptoms, recurrent bleeding, fever, facial swelling, or breathing difficulty can indicate a more serious cause.

Nasal Corticosteroid Sprays

Nasal corticosteroid sprays reduce mucosal inflammation and congestion in allergic rhinitis, nasal polyps, and some chronic sinus disorders; correct direction away from the septum limits irritation and nosebleeds.

Nasal Discharge

Alternate name; see *Rhinorrhea*.

Nasal Disorders

Conditions affecting the nose or nasal passages, including infection, allergy, trauma, obstruction, polyps, and tumors.

Nasal Endoscopy

An examination in which a thin camera is used to look inside the nose and upper throat. It can help find swelling, polyps, a foreign object, bleeding, or a growth.

Nasal Flaring

Widening and outward movement of the nostrils during breathing. It is a visible sign of increased work of breathing, particularly in infants and children, and may accompany airway obstruction, bronchiolitis, pneumonia, asthma, or severe systemic illness.

Nasal Foreign Body

An object lodged in a nasal passage, most often in a child. One-sided obstruction, foul-smelling discharge, bleeding, pain, or difficulty breathing may occur; button batteries and paired magnets

can rapidly damage nasal tissue.

Nasal Foreign Bodies

Alternate name; see *Nasal Foreign Body*.

Nasal Fracture

A break in one or more bones or cartilaginous structures of the nose, usually caused by facial trauma. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, bleeding, and nasal obstruction may occur; a septal hematoma can damage the nasal cartilage.

Nasal Furunculosis

A bacterial infection of a hair follicle in the nasal vestibule, usually caused by *Staphylococcus aureus*. It causes a tender, red swelling and may form a localized abscess or spread into nearby skin.

Nasal Implant

A medical device placed inside or near the nose to support weakened tissue, change nasal shape, or improve airflow. The implant may be temporary or permanent, and risks include infection, movement, scarring, or breathing problems.

Nasal Leech

A rare infestation in which a leech attaches to the lining of the nose, often after exposure to contaminated freshwater. It can cause repeated nosebleeds, nasal blockage, or a sensation of movement in the nose because leech saliva prevents blood from clotting.

Nasal Mucosal Biopsy

Removal of a small piece of tissue from the nose for laboratory examination. It may help investigate persistent inflammation, infection, unusual deposits, or a growth; soreness, bleeding, and infection are possible complications.

Nasal Obstruction

Blocked airflow through one or both nasal passages. Causes include congestion, allergy, infection, a deviated septum, polyps, trauma, or a mass. Persistent one-sided obstruction or bleeding can be associated with a mass or other structural condition.

Nasal Papilloma

A usually benign epithelial tumor arising from the lining of the nasal cavity or paranasal sinuses. Sinonasal papillomas include exophytic, inverted, and oncocytic types; some can recur, and the inverted and oncocytic types may become malignant.

Alternate Names:
Sinonasal Papilloma; Schneiderian Papilloma

Nasal Passage

One of the air channels inside the nose. Its lining warms, moistens, and filters inhaled air before it reaches the throat; swelling, mucus, polyps, or a structural blockage can make breathing difficult.

Nasal Polyps

Soft, usually noncancerous growths in the lining of the nose or sinuses. They can cause a blocked nose, runny nose, and reduced sense of smell.

Alternate Names:
Sinonasal Polyps; Nasal Polyposis

Nasal Septal Abscess

A collection of pus between the nasal septum and its overlying lining, usually caused by bacterial infection of a septal hematoma or another local infection. It can cut off the cartilage's blood supply, causing cartilage damage, perforation, or nasal deformity.

Nasal Septal Hematoma

A collection of blood beneath the lining of the nasal septum, usually after nasal trauma. It can obstruct airflow and compromise the cartilage's blood supply, causing necrosis, infection, or septal deformity.

Nasal Septal Perforation

A hole through the cartilage or bone separating the nasal passages, which may cause crusting, nosebleeds, whistling, or obstruction and can result from trauma, surgery, intranasal drugs, or inflammatory disease.

Nasal Septal Perforation Repair

A procedure to close or reconstruct a hole in the nasal septum, using local tissue, grafts, or other techniques when symptoms or progressive damage justify repair.

Nasal Septum

The wall that divides the nasal cavity into right and left sides. It consists mainly of cartilage in front and bone behind and helps support the nose and direct airflow.

Nasal Septum Perforation

Alternate name; see *Nasal Septal Perforation*.

Nasal Spray

A liquid or mist delivered into the nose. Different sprays contain saline, corticosteroids, antihistamines, or decongestants; correct use and duration depend on the product.

Nasal Stent

A small device placed inside the nose to keep an airway open or support healing after surgery. It may cause crusting, blockage, infection, bleeding, or pressure injury.

Nasal Vestibular Stenosis

Narrowing of the nasal vestibule or nearby nasal valve that restricts airflow through the nostril. It may be present from birth or develop after injury, surgery, infection, or scarring.

Nasal Vestibulitis

Inflammation or infection of the nasal vestibule, commonly caused by Staphylococcus bacteria and producing tenderness, crusting, redness, or small pustules near the nostrils.

Nasogastric Feeding Tube

A flexible tube passed through the nose into the stomach to deliver enteral nutrition or medicines, or to decompress or aspirate the stomach.

Nasogastric Tube

A tube passed through the nose into the stomach to remove contents or deliver nutrition, fluids, or medicines when clinically indicated.

Nasogastric Tube Insertion

The placement of a flexible plastic tube through the nose, down the esophagus, and into the stomach for feeding, medication administration, or gastric decompression; see *Nasogastric Tube*.

Nasojejunal Feeding Tube

A flexible tube passed through the nose and stomach, with its tip placed in the jejunum beyond the stomach. It delivers enteral nutrition when feeding into the stomach is unsuitable or poorly tolerated, including in selected cases of delayed gastric emptying or aspiration risk. Placement may be guided by imaging or endoscopy.

Alternate Names:
NJ Tube

Nasolacrimal Duct

A membranous canal enclosed within a bony canal that conveys tears from the lacrimal sac downward into the inferior meatus of the nasal cavity beneath the inferior nasal concha, guarded by the mucosal valve of Hasner.

Alternate Names:
Tear Duct

Nasopharyngeal Airway

A soft tube inserted through the nose to maintain a passage between the nares and pharynx. It may be useful in a spontaneously breathing patient with partial upper-airway obstruction but is relatively contraindicated in suspected basal skull fracture or significant nasal trauma.

Nasopharyngeal Cancer

Cancer arising in the upper throat behind the nose, most often a carcinoma associated with Epstein-Barr virus in endemic regions. Nasal obstruction, nosebleeds, hearing loss, neck nodes, or cranial-nerve symptoms may occur; endoscopy, biopsy, and imaging establish extent.

Nasopharyngeal Carcinoma

A cancer arising in the upper throat behind the nose. It may cause a blocked or bleeding nose, hearing problems, a neck lump, headache, or swallowing trouble; risk varies with genetics, infections, and geographic background.

Alternate Names:
NPC; Nasopharyngeal Cancer

Nasopharyngeal Culture

A laboratory test in which a sample from behind the nose is placed in a growth medium to look for selected bacteria or fungi. A negative result does not exclude every infection, and other tests may be more sensitive.

Nasopharynx

The upper part of the throat behind the nose and above the soft palate. It carries air, contains the openings of the tubes that connect to the middle ears, and includes nearby lymph tissue that helps defend against infection.

Natal Cleft

The groove between the buttocks, also called the intergluteal or sacral cleft.

Alternate Names:
Intergluteal Cleft; Sacral Cleft

Natal Teeth

Teeth present at birth, most often involving the lower central incisors. They may be loose, interfere with feeding, or injure the infant's tongue; a loose tooth can pose an aspiration risk.

Natriuresis

Removal of sodium from the body in urine. Water usually leaves with the sodium, which can reduce fluid volume and blood pressure; the process may be increased by natural hormones or water-removing medicines.

Natriuretic

Causing the kidneys to remove more sodium in urine. Water usually leaves with the sodium, which can lower blood volume and pressure. The term describes certain body hormones and some medicines; related blood tests can help assess heart failure.

Natural Immunity

Immunity developed after a person is infected with a disease-causing organism. This is a form of active immunity because the person's own immune system responds. Antibodies passed from a pregnant person to a fetus or infant provide passive immunity, a separate form of naturally acquired protection that is temporary.

Natural Killer Cell

A type of white blood cell that can recognize and destroy some virus-infected or abnormal cells without previous exposure to that specific target. It helps provide early immune defense and releases signals that guide other immune cells.

Alternate Names:
NK Cells

Natural Killer Cells

Alternate plural form; see *Natural Killer Cell*.

Naturopathic Medicine

A system of complementary or alternative health practices that may use diet, supplements, herbs, and other treatments.

Nausea

An unpleasant feeling that you may vomit. It can occur with stomach or intestinal illness, pregnancy, medicines, migraine, inner-ear problems, metabolic disorders, or serious abdominal or neurologic disease. Persistent vomiting, severe pain, dehydration, blood, or confusion may signal a serious condition.

Nausea And Vomiting

Nausea is the urge to vomit; vomiting is forceful emptying of stomach contents. Causes include infection, medicines, pregnancy, migraine, obstruction, and other illnesses.

Nausea And Vomiting – Adults

Nausea and vomiting in adults can result from infection, stomach or bowel disease, medicines, pregnancy, migraine, metabolic illness, neurologic disease, or blockage. Severe pain, blood, confusion, dehydration, chest symptoms, or persistent symptoms may indicate a serious condition.

Nausea And Vomiting During Early Pregnancy

Nausea and vomiting are common in early pregnancy, but persistent symptoms with inability to keep fluids down, weight loss, dehydration, abdominal pain, fever, blood, or altered mental status may indicate hyperemesis gravidarum or another significant condition.

Navel

The navel, or umbilicus, is the scar left after the umbilical cord separates and marks the former connection between fetus and placenta.

Navicular

A boat-shaped bone in the middle of the foot that helps support the arch. Injury to it can cause foot pain and may heal slowly because part of the bone has a limited blood supply.

Navicular Fracture

A break in the navicular bone of the foot, caused by acute trauma or repetitive loading. Midfoot pain, swelling, and tenderness over the navicular may occur, and some fractures are difficult to detect without advanced imaging.

Navicular Fracture of the Wrist

A fracture of the scaphoid, a small wrist bone historically called the navicular. It may cause pain in the anatomic snuffbox after a fall and can heal poorly because part of the bone has limited blood supply.

Alternate Names:
Scaphoid Fracture; Wrist Navicular Fracture

NCS

Usually an abbreviation for nerve-conduction study, a test that measures how quickly and strongly electrical signals travel through nerves. It can help assess nerve damage, pressure on a nerve, or some causes of numbness and weakness.

NDI

Abbreviation for nephrogenic diabetes insipidus, in which the kidneys do not respond adequately to vasopressin and produce excessive dilute urine; see *Nephrogenic Diabetes Insipidus*.

NDM-1

An enzyme made by some bacteria that makes them resistant to many important antibiotics. Infections caused by these bacteria can be difficult to treat; laboratory identification and infection-control measures help limit spread.

Near-Drowning

An older term for *non-fatal drowning*: respiratory impairment from submersion or immersion in liquid when the person survives. “Non-fatal drowning” is the preferred term.

Alternate Names:
Non-Fatal Drowning

Nearsightedness

A common focusing problem in which nearby objects are clear but distant objects look blurry because light focuses in front of the retina. Glasses, contact lenses, or selected procedures can improve vision.

Alternate Names:
Myopia; Short-Sightedness

Nearsightedness (Myopia)

Alternate name; see *Nearsightedness*.

Nebulizer

A device that converts liquid medicine into an aerosol for inhalation through a mouthpiece or mask. Common types include jet nebulizers, ultrasonic nebulizers, and vibrating-mesh nebulizers; they differ in how the aerosol is generated and delivered.

Alternate Names:
Nebuliser; Atomizer

NEC

Abbreviation; see *Neuroendocrine Carcinoma*.

Necator

A group of hookworms that live in the small intestine. They enter through the skin, mature in the gut, and feed on blood, potentially causing abdominal symptoms, iron-deficiency anemia, weakness, and poor growth.

Necator Americanus

A hookworm species that infects humans through skin penetration by larvae and causes intestinal blood loss.

Neck

The neck connects the head to the trunk and contains the cervical spine, airway, esophagus, thyroid, vessels, nerves, muscles, and lymph nodes.

Neck And Back Pain

Pain in the neck, upper back, lower back, or surrounding tissues, commonly caused by strain, age-related changes, disc problems, or trauma. Weakness, numbness, walking difficulty, bowel or bladder changes, fever, cancer history, or major trauma may indicate a serious cause.

Neck Abscess

A pocket of pus in the skin or deeper tissues of the neck, usually caused by infection. It may cause pain, swelling, fever, or trouble swallowing; a deep abscess can threaten breathing.

Neck Cancer

Cancer arising in tissues of the neck, such as the throat, thyroid, salivary glands, lymph nodes, or other structures. Symptoms may include a persistent lump, pain, swallowing trouble, voice change, or unexplained weight loss.

Neck Dissection

Surgical removal of cervical lymph nodes and sometimes surrounding tissues to treat or stage head and neck cancer.

Neck Lump

A localized swelling or mass in the neck caused by enlarged lymph nodes, thyroid or salivary disease, cyst, infection, or tumor; persistent or concerning masses can reflect significant disease.

Neck Lipoma

A usually harmless, soft lump made of fat cells under the skin of the neck. It often grows slowly and may move slightly when pressed.

Neck Lymphoma

Lymphoma involving lymph nodes or other lymph tissue in the neck. It may cause one or more painless lumps and can occur with fever, night sweats, or unexplained weight loss.

Neck Mass

A lump or swelling in the neck caused by an enlarged lymph node, congenital cyst, thyroid or salivary-gland lesion, infection, or tumor. A persistent, enlarging, firm, fixed, or unexplained mass—especially in an adult—can be associated with malignancy or other significant disease.

Neck Pain

Pain or stiffness in the neck, commonly caused by muscle strain, poor posture, injury, arthritis, degenerative disc disease, or nerve compression. It may be localized or spread to the shoulders, arms, or head.

Neck Pain And Dizziness

Neck pain with dizziness may reflect muscle strain, migraine, inner-ear disease, medication, blood-pressure change, or less commonly vascular or neurologic disease. Sudden severe symptoms, weakness, speech or vision change, fainting, or inability to walk may occur with a serious condition.

Neck Sprain

Alternate name; see *Whiplash*.

Neck Stiffness

Reduced ability to move the neck comfortably because of muscle tightness, inflammation, injury, or irritation of tissues around the spine or meninges. Severe stiffness with fever, headache, confusion, rash, or neurologic symptoms can occur with serious infection or neurologic disease.

Neck Strain

Alternate name; see *Whiplash*.

Neck X-Ray

Plain radiographic imaging of the cervical spine or neck soft tissues used to evaluate alignment, fractures, degenerative change, foreign bodies, or selected airway abnormalities.

Necrobiosis Lipoidica

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder characterized by yellow-brown, atrophic plaques, usually on the shins. It is associated with diabetes but can occur without diabetes.

Necrobiosis Lipoidica Diabeticorum

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder producing yellow-brown atrophic plaques with a raised border, most often on the shins and associated with diabetes, although it can occur without diabetes.

Necrolytic Acral Erythema

A rare rash with dark, thickened, or blistered patches, usually on the feet and ankles. It is often linked to long-term hepatitis C but can also occur with low zinc or other metabolic problems; these associations help distinguish possible causes.

Alternate Names:
NAE; Hepatitis C-Associated Necrolytic Erythema

Necrolytic Migratory Erythema

A recurrent skin eruption with red patches that develop blisters, erosions, or crusts and spread to new areas as older lesions heal. It often affects skin folds, the groin, buttocks, or areas around the mouth. It is a characteristic feature of glucagonoma, a glucagon-producing pancreatic tumor, but similar eruptions can occur with liver disease, intestinal malabsorption, or chronic pancreatitis; these are sometimes called pseudoglucagonoma syndrome.

Necrosis

Necrosis is death of cells or tissue within a living body caused by ischemia, infection, toxins, trauma, inflammation, or other injury.

Necrotizing Anterior Scleritis

A severe inflammation of the white outer coat of the eye that causes tissue damage and can threaten vision. It usually causes intense eye pain, redness, and light sensitivity.

Necrotizing Enterocolitis

A severe intestinal disease of newborns, especially premature or medically fragile infants, in which inflammation damages and may kill bowel tissue. Injury can extend through the bowel wall and cause perforation, peritonitis, or sepsis. Abdominal distension, feeding intolerance, and bloody stools are common findings.

Necrotizing Fasciitis

A rare, severe, and rapidly spreading bacterial infection of the deep layers of skin and subcutaneous connective tissue (the fascia). As the bacteria multiply, they release toxins that destroy surrounding tissues, cut off blood supply, and cause tissue death (necrosis). Often beginning after a minor cut, scrape, or surgical wound, it quickly produces severe pain that seems out of proportion to the visible skin changes, followed by rapid swelling, blister formation, skin discoloration, and life-threatening systemic shock.

Alternate Names:
Necrotizing Soft Tissue Infection (NSTI); Flesh-Eating Disease

Necrotizing Fasciitis of the Perineum

Necrotizing soft-tissue infection of the perineum or genital region, commonly called Fournier gangrene. Severe pain, swelling, skin discoloration,

fever, or rapid progression can occur; treatment involves emergency surgery and antibiotics.

Alternate Names:
Fournier Gangrene

Necrotizing Granuloma

A granulomatous inflammatory lesion containing central tissue necrosis, commonly associated with infections such as tuberculosis or fungal disease but requiring clinical and histologic correlation.

Necrotizing Infections

Severe infections that cause tissue death through germs, toxins, blocked blood flow, or intense inflammation. Examples include necrotizing fasciitis, necrotizing pneumonia, and necrotizing enterocolitis. Rapidly worsening pain, swelling, skin changes, severe illness, or organ problems may occur.

Necrotizing Pneumonia

Severe pneumonia in which infection causes necrosis and cavitation of lung tissue, often accompanied by sepsis, respiratory failure, or abscess formation.

Necrotizing Sialometaplasia

A benign, self-limiting, ischemic inflammatory lesion of the salivary glands (most commonly involving the minor salivary glands of the hard palate) that clinically and histologically mimics mucoepidermoid carcinoma or squamous cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Ischemic Sialadenitis; Benign Palatal Sialometaplasia

Necrotizing Soft Tissue Infection

A rapidly progressive infection of the tissue beneath the skin or in muscle that causes severe pain, swelling, severe illness, and tissue death. Treatment may include surgery and antibiotics.

Necrotizing Vasculitis

Inflammation of blood-vessel walls causing fibrinoid necrosis and potential vessel narrowing, thrombosis, hemorrhage, ischemia, or organ injury.

Needle

A hollow, sharp tube used to inject medicine or remove blood, fluid, or tissue. Needles come in different lengths and widths; the appropriate size depends on the procedure and body site.

Needle Aspiration Biopsy

A biopsy that uses a thin needle to remove cells or fluid from a lump, organ, or lesion for laboratory examination. Results are interpreted with imaging and clinical findings and may require a larger biopsy.

Needle Biopsy

Removal of cells, fluid, or a tissue sample through a needle for cytologic or histopathologic examination. Fine-needle aspiration primarily collects cells, whereas core biopsy collects tissue architecture.

Needle Decompression

An emergency procedure used to release trapped air from around a collapsed lung when a tension pneumothorax is causing severe breathing or circulation problems. A trained clinician places a needle or catheter through the chest, then usually inserts a chest tube for ongoing treatment. It is a temporary lifesaving measure, not a complete repair.

Alternate Names:
Needle Thoracostomy; Tension Pneumothorax Decompression; Emergency Chest Decompression

Needle Driver

A surgical instrument with gripping jaws and handles used to hold and guide a suture needle through tissue. Its design helps control the needle while protecting the operator's fingers.

Alternate Names:
Needle Holder Suture Needle Holder

Needle Holder

Alternate name; see *Needle Driver*.

Needlestick Injury

A puncture from a needle or sharp object that may expose someone to blood or body fluids. It can create a risk of infection, including HIV or hepatitis,

and may lead to testing or preventive treatment.

Neer Sign

A shoulder examination finding in which pain occurs as the clinician raises the person's straight arm forward while turning it inward. It may support a diagnosis of subacromial shoulder pain, but does not identify its cause by itself.

Alternate Names:
Neer Impingement Test

Neer Test

Alternate name; see *Neer Sign*.

Alternate Names:
Neer Impingement Sign; Neer Shoulder Test

Negative Feedback

A control process in which a change triggers a response that reduces or reverses the original change. It helps keep body functions, such as temperature, blood sugar, and hormone levels, within a useful range.

Negative Predictive Value

The chance that a person with a negative test result truly does not have the condition. It depends on test accuracy and how common or likely the condition was before testing.

Negative Pressure Pulmonary Edema

A form of non-cardiogenic pulmonary edema provoked by vigorous, forceful inspiratory efforts against an acutely obstructed upper airway (such as post-extubation laryngospasm), generating extreme negative intrathoracic pressures that increase venous return and cause alveolar capillary stress failure.

Alternate Names:
NPPE; Post-Obstructive Pulmonary Edema

Negative Pressure Ventilation

Breathing support that uses pressure around the chest to help the lungs expand, instead of pushing air directly through the airway. It is used rarely, including for some neuromuscular conditions.

Negative-Strand RNA Virus

A virus whose genetic material cannot be read directly to make proteins. After entering a cell, it must first make a readable copy of its RNA before producing new virus particles.

Negative Symptoms

A reduction or loss of usual emotional expression, speech, motivation, pleasure, or interest in other people. They can occur in schizophrenia and some other conditions and may interfere with work, relationships, and daily activities.

Neglect

Failure to provide a child with necessary food, shelter, supervision, education, emotional care, or medical care, causing harm or risk of harm. The term can also describe ignoring one side of space after brain injury; the intended meaning depends on context.

Neglected Tropical Disease

An infectious or parasitic disease that mainly affects populations in tropical or subtropical regions with limited resources. Examples include schistosomiasis, leprosy, dengue, and lymphatic filariasis.

Neglect Syndrome

A neurologic problem in which a person fails to notice or respond to one side of the body or surrounding space, usually after injury to the opposite side of the brain. It is more than ordinary inattention.

Neisseria Gonorrhoeae

A gram-negative bacterium that causes gonorrhea, a sexually transmitted infection. It has developed resistance to several antibiotics, so treatment follows current local guidance.

Neisseria Infection

Infection caused by a pathogenic Neisseria species. The most important human infections are gonorrhoea caused by N. gonorrhoeae and meningococcal disease caused by N. meningitidis; illness may affect the genital tract, throat, rectum, joints, bloodstream, or meninges, and treatment depends on the

site and antibiotic susceptibility.

Alternate Names:
Neisseria Infections

Neisseria Meningitidis

A gram-negative diplococcus that can cause meningitis or bloodstream infection (meningococcemia). Its polysaccharide capsule defines major disease-causing serogroups; conjugate vaccines target serogroups A, C, W, and Y, while serogroup B vaccines target surface proteins. Meningitis may cause fever, headache, neck stiffness, or altered mental status.

Nelson Syndrome

Enlargement and hypersecretion of an adrenocorticotropic-hormone-producing pituitary tumour after bilateral adrenalectomy, usually for Cushing disease. It may cause rapid skin hyperpigmentation, headache, visual-field loss, and other effects of an expanding sellar mass.

Nemaline Myopathy

A group of inherited muscle diseases that cause weakness because muscle fibers do not develop or work normally. Severe forms begin in infancy and may affect movement, feeding, or breathing; milder forms begin later. The severity varies widely, and care may include breathing support, nutrition, physical therapy, and genetic counseling.

Alternate Names:
Rod Body Myopathy; Nemaline Rod Myopathy

Neoadjuvant Therapy

Treatment given before the main treatment, such as surgery or radiotherapy, to shrink a tumor or make it easier to treat. It may also show how the tumor responds and help doctors plan the next treatment.

Neocortex

The outer part of the cerebral hemispheres involved in conscious perception, language, planning, memory, and voluntary movement.

Neoehrlichiosis

A tick-borne bacterial infection caused by *Candidatus Neoehrlichia mikurensis*, usually transmitted by *Ixodes* ticks. It may cause fever, fatigue, muscle or joint pain, and skin findings; vascular inflammation and venous or arterial thromboembolic events can also occur, particularly in immunocompromised people.

Neologisms

Newly created words, phrases, or idiosyncratic combinations of word fragments that have meaning only to the speaker and are incomprehensible to others. They are characteristic features of formal thought disorder in schizophrenia and fluent (Wernicke) aphasia.

Neonatal

Relating to a newborn, especially during the first 28 days after birth. This period includes important changes in breathing, feeding, temperature control, immunity, circulation, and adjustment to life outside the womb.

Neonatal Abstinence Syndrome

Withdrawal symptoms in a newborn after exposure to opioids or certain other medicines or substances during pregnancy. Symptoms may include trembling, irritability, poor feeding, vomiting, diarrhea, sweating, or breathing problems.

Neonatal Cephalohematoma

A collection of blood beneath the outer covering of a newborn's skull, usually caused by birth trauma. It is limited by the skull's seams and generally resolves over time, but it can be associated with injury or jaundice.

Neonatal Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the eye's outer lining during the first month of life, caused by chemical irritation, bacteria, or viruses acquired during delivery. Pus-like discharge, eyelid swelling, and corneal involvement may occur.

Neonatal Cystic Fibrosis Screening Test

A newborn screening test, usually measuring immunoreactive trypsinogen with reflex DNA or sweat

testing, used to identify infants at increased risk for cystic fibrosis.

Neonatal Diabetes Mellitus

Diabetes first diagnosed during the first six months of life. It may be temporary or lifelong and is usually caused by a genetic change affecting insulin production; management often involves specialist care.

Neonatal Encephalopathy

A syndrome of disturbed brain function in a newborn, ranging from abnormal alertness or muscle tone to seizures or coma. Causes include hypoxic-ischemic injury, infection, stroke, metabolic disorders, and genetic conditions; it is broader than hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Newborn Encephalopathy

Neonatal Galactorrhea

Milk-like secretion from a newborn's breast tissue, usually related to hormonal changes around birth. It is usually temporary; persistent secretion can be associated with endocrine disorders.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Milk Secretion; Newborn Galactorrhea

Neonatal Harlequin Color Change

A brief, harmless color change in a newborn in which one side of the body becomes red while the other remains pale, with a sharp line between them. It reflects temporary differences in blood-vessel control and usually resolves without treatment.

Neonatal Hepatitis

An older, broad term for liver inflammation and poor bile flow in a newborn, often causing prolonged jaundice. Many cases once given this name have a specific cause, such as infection, blocked bile ducts, or an inherited disease. When no cause is found, idiopathic neonatal cholestasis is a more precise term.

Neonatal Herpes Simplex

Herpes simplex infection in a baby during the first 28 days of life, usually acquired around delivery. It may affect the skin, eyes, mouth, brain, or several organs and can resemble sepsis. Treatment uses antiviral medicine.

Neonatal Herpes Simplex Virus

A severe neonatal infection caused by herpes simplex virus, typically acquired during passage through the birth canal, presenting within the first month of life as skin, eye, and mouth disease, central nervous system disease, or disseminated disease with multiorgan involvement.

Neonatal Hyperbilirubinemia

An excess of bilirubin in a newborn's blood that can cause yellowing of the skin and eyes (jaundice). Very high levels can injure the brain, causing acute bilirubin encephalopathy or lasting injury known as kernicterus.

Neonatal Hyperglycemia

Blood glucose higher than expected in a newborn. The level considered high depends on the infant's age, gestational age, and clinical situation. Causes include prematurity, infection, stress, or receiving too much glucose through a vein.

Alternate Names:
Newborn Hyperglycemia

Neonatal Hypertension

Sustained blood pressure elevation in infants and neonates exceeding age- and birthweight-adjusted norms. Frequently secondary to umbilical artery catheter-related renal artery thrombosis, congenital renal anomalies, bronchopulmonary dysplasia, or congenital heart defects.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal High Blood Pressure

Neonatal Hypocalcemia

Low serum calcium in a newborn, which may cause jitteriness, poor feeding, hypotonia, apnea, or seizures. Causes include prematurity, maternal diabetes, birth asphyxia, and disorders of parathyroid

function.

Neonatal Hypoglycemia

A low blood glucose level in a newborn. It may cause trembling, sleepiness, poor feeding, breathing pauses, or seizures and is more likely with prematurity, unusually small or large birth size, or maternal diabetes.

Neonatal Hypothermia

A newborn's body temperature below 36.5°C. It can result from environmental exposure, prematurity, infection, or other illness and can worsen breathing, blood glucose, and circulation problems.

Neonatal Hypothyroidism

Insufficient thyroid hormone production in a newborn, which can impair brain development and growth if untreated; newborn screening enables early diagnosis and treatment.

Neonatal Hypoxic-Ischemic Encephalopathy

Brain injury in a newborn caused by too little oxygen or blood flow around the time of birth. It may cause poor alertness, abnormal muscle tone, seizures, breathing difficulty, or injury to other organs. Selected babies benefit from carefully controlled cooling started soon after birth.

Neonatal Infections

Infections occurring during the first weeks of a newborn's life. They may begin before or soon after birth from exposure during pregnancy or delivery, or later from the environment or medical devices. Warning signs include poor feeding, temperature change, breathing difficulty, unusual sleepiness, irritability, or color change.

Neonatal Jaundice

Yellow discoloration of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by elevated bilirubin. It is common; severe, early, or prolonged jaundice can reflect high bilirubin levels or an underlying disorder.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Hyperbilirubinemia; Icterus Neonatorum

Neonatal Listeriosis

Listeria infection acquired before birth or during delivery that can cause sepsis, pneumonia, meningitis, or other serious illness in a newborn; see *Listeriosis*.

Neonatal Lupus

An antibody-mediated condition in a fetus or newborn caused by placental transfer of maternal anti-Ro/SSA and/or anti-La/SSB antibodies. The mother may have lupus or Sjögren syndrome, or may have no symptoms. The infant may develop a skin rash, low blood-cell counts, liver abnormalities, or heart injury, especially congenital heart block. Skin, blood, and liver findings usually resolve as the maternal antibodies disappear over several months, but established heart block is often permanent and may require a pacemaker; this condition does not mean the infant has systemic lupus.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Lupus Erythematosus; NLE

Neonatal Mechanical Ventilation

Breathing support for a newborn who cannot breathe adequately without help. Air may be delivered through a breathing tube or a mask; the method and settings are chosen for the infant's condition.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Ventilatory Support

Neonatal Neutropenia

A low number of neutrophils, a type of white blood cell, in a newborn's blood. The cutoff depends on gestational age and the infant's age after birth. Causes include infection, maternal conditions, immune problems, medicines, or bone-marrow disorders.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Low Neutrophil Count

Neonatal Opioid Withdrawal Syndrome

A withdrawal syndrome in a newborn after prenatal opioid exposure. Features can include irritability, tremor, high-pitched crying, disturbed sleep, poor feeding, vomiting, loose stools, and sweating, reflecting effects on the central nervous, autonomic, and

gastrointestinal systems. Onset and severity vary with the opioid, timing and duration of exposure, and exposure to other substances.

Alternate Names:
NOWS; Opioid-Induced NAS

Neonatal Peripheral Arterial Line

A fine indwelling cannula placed in a peripheral artery (such as the radial, posterior tibial, or dorsalis pedis artery) of an infant for continuous invasive hemodynamic arterial blood pressure monitoring and frequent arterial blood gas sampling in neonatal intensive care.

Alternate Names:
Infant Arterial Line; Pediatric A-Line; Neonatal Arterial Cannulation

Neonatal Peripheral IV Line

A short peripheral venous catheter inserted into a superficial vein in the hand, foot, forearm, or scalp of an infant for short-term hydration, medication delivery, or blood transfusions.

Alternate Names:
Infant PIV; Pediatric Peripheral Cannula; Neonatal IV Cannulation

Neonatal PICC Line

A small-caliber (1.0–2.0 Fr) central venous catheter inserted percutaneously into a peripheral vein of an infant or neonate with the tip positioned in the superior or inferior vena cava, providing reliable vascular access for total parenteral nutrition and hyperosmolar medications.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Percutaneous Central Line; Infant PICC; Pediatric Percutaneous Central Catheter

Neonatal Pneumothorax

Air in the pleural space of a newborn, which can compress the lung and impair breathing. It may occur spontaneously or with lung disease, resuscitation, or mechanical ventilation; severity ranges from an imaging finding to a life-threatening emergency.

Alternate Names:
Newborn Pleural Air Collection

Neonatal Polycythemia

An abnormally high red-cell concentration in a newborn, often defined by a venous hematocrit of at least 65 percent. It may increase blood viscosity and cause respiratory, neurologic, or metabolic symptoms.

Neonatal Respiratory Distress Syndrome

A lung disorder of newborns, especially those born preterm, caused chiefly by insufficient pulmonary surfactant and immature lungs. Increased surface tension promotes alveolar collapse, impairing oxygen exchange and causing early respiratory distress. "Hyaline membrane disease" is an older name.

Neonatal Resuscitation

Emergency steps used to help a newborn who is not breathing well or has a slow heart rate after birth. They may include warmth, airway support, assisted breathing, and chest compressions.

Neonatal Seizures

Seizures occurring in a newborn, usually during the first 28 days after birth. They may be subtle or detectable only with electroencephalography (EEG). Causes include oxygen-related brain injury, stroke or bleeding, infection, low blood sugar or calcium, and genetic or metabolic conditions; they can indicate serious neurologic or metabolic disease.

Neonatal Sepsis

A serious infection causing illness throughout a newborn's body during the first 28 days of life. It may begin before or after birth and can cause poor feeding, temperature change, breathing difficulty, sleepiness, or color change.

Neonatal Skin Conditions

Skin changes common in newborns, including temporary rashes, tiny white spots, heat rash, and small yellow bumps. Most are harmless, but blistering, widespread redness, fever, poor feeding, or a rapidly worsening rash may signal illness.

Neonatal Testicular Torsion

Twisting of the spermatic cord around a testicle

during the newborn period, reducing or stopping its blood supply. It may appear as a firm, enlarged, discolored, or painless scrotal swelling.

Neonatal Thyrotoxicosis

Excess thyroid activity in a newborn, usually caused by thyroid-stimulating antibodies passed from the mother. It may cause a fast heartbeat, irritability, poor feeding, poor weight gain, sweating, or breathing problems and usually needs temporary treatment and monitoring.

Neonatal Transition

The newborn's adjustment from receiving oxygen through the placenta to breathing with the lungs after birth. The lungs fill with air, blood flow changes, and the baby must begin controlling temperature, blood pressure, and feeding.

Neonate

A neonate is a newborn infant during the first 28 completed days after birth, a period requiring attention to feeding, temperature, jaundice, infection, breathing, and transition to extrauterine life.

Neonatologist

A pediatrician who specializes in the medical care of newborn infants, particularly premature and critically ill neonates.

Neoplasia

Abnormal, uncontrolled growth of cells that forms a new mass or tissue. It may be benign and remain localized, or malignant and invade nearby tissues or spread elsewhere.

Neoplasm

A new, abnormal growth of cells that forms a mass or tissue. A neoplasm may be benign and stay localized, or malignant and invade nearby tissues or spread to distant organs.

Neoplastic

Relating to an abnormal new growth of cells. A neoplastic growth may be noncancerous and localized or cancerous and able to invade nearby tissue or spread.

Neostigmine

An acetylcholinesterase inhibitor used to reverse selected nondepolarizing neuromuscular blockade and to treat some disorders of neuromuscular transmission or bowel and bladder motility.

Nephoptosis

Alternate spelling; see *Nephroptosis*.

Nephrectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of a kidney. It may treat kidney cancer, severe kidney damage, infection, or a kidney that no longer works.

Nephric

Relating to the kidney. In embryology, nephric structures are involved in development of the urinary system.

Nephritic Syndrome

A kidney disorder caused by acute inflammation and damage to the glomeruli, the microscopic filtering units of the kidneys. This inflammation allows red blood cells and moderate amounts of protein to leak into the urine, classically resulting in dark or tea-colored urine (hematuria). It typically presents with a sudden decline in kidney function, fluid retention causing body swelling (edema), and high blood pressure.

Nephritis

Inflammation of kidney tissue that can cause blood or protein in the urine, swelling, high blood pressure, reduced urine, or loss of kidney function. Infection, medicines, and immune diseases are possible causes.

Nephroblastoma

Another name for Wilms tumor, the most common kidney cancer in children. It may appear as a painless abdominal lump, abdominal pain, blood in the urine, fever, or high blood pressure; treatment is usually provided by a specialist cancer team.

Nephrocalcinosis

Buildup of calcium deposits inside kidney tissue. It may result from high calcium levels, hormone or kidney disorders, inherited conditions, dehydration, or medicines and can lead to stones, blood in the urine, or reduced kidney function.

Nephrocarcinoma

A carcinoma arising in the kidney, usually referring to renal cell carcinoma; see *Renal Cell Carcinoma*.

Nephrogenic Diabetes Insipidus

A condition in which the kidneys do not respond properly to vasopressin, the hormone that helps conserve water. It causes large amounts of dilute urine and intense thirst; inherited changes, kidney disease, electrolyte problems, or medicines may cause it.

Nephrogenic Fibrosing Dermopathy

An older name for nephrogenic systemic fibrosis, a rare condition causing thick, tight, hardened skin and sometimes stiff joints in people with severe kidney disease, usually after exposure to certain gadolinium contrast agents.

Nephrogenic Systemic Fibrosis

A rare disorder in which skin and connective tissue become thick and hardened, sometimes limiting movement. It is linked mainly to certain gadolinium contrast exposures in people with severe kidney impairment and may affect internal tissues.

Nephrolithiasis

Formation of stones in the kidneys or urinary tract. Stones can cause severe side or back pain, blood in the urine, nausea, or blockage; dehydration, inherited conditions, medicines, and diet can contribute.

Nephrologist

A doctor who specializes in kidney disease. Nephrologists assess reduced kidney function, high blood pressure related to kidney problems, kidney inflammation, and mineral or salt disturbances and may manage dialysis or transplant care.

Nephrology

The medical specialty concerned with kidney disease, fluid and electrolyte disorders, hypertension, dialysis, and kidney transplantation.

Nephrolysis

Surgical freeing of a kidney from surrounding adhesions or tissue.

Nephron

The microscopic working unit of a kidney. Each nephron filters blood, returns needed water and substances to the body, and removes waste to make urine; each kidney contains about one million.

Nephron Function

Each kidney contains about one million nephrons, its microscopic filtering units. A nephron filters blood, removes wastes into urine, and returns needed water and substances to the bloodstream while helping control salts, acid, and blood pressure.

Nephronophthisis

A rare inherited kidney disease that gradually reduces the kidneys' ability to concentrate urine. It may cause excessive thirst and urination, anemia, growth problems, and eventually kidney failure.

Nephropathy

Disease or damage of the kidneys. It may reduce waste removal, disturb fluid and salt balance, cause protein or blood in the urine, or eventually lead to kidney failure.

Nephropathy Diabetic

Alternate name; see *Diabetic Nephropathy*.

Nephroptosis

Abnormal downward movement of a kidney when a person stands, sometimes causing flank discomfort, urinary symptoms, or intermittent obstruction.

Alternate Names:
Wandering Kidney; Floating Kidney; Ren Mobilis; Hypermobile Kidney

Nephrosclerosis

Hardening and scarring of kidney tissue, commonly caused by long-standing high blood pressure or blood-vessel disease. Progressive damage can reduce filtering ability, cause protein in urine, and lead to chronic kidney disease.

Nephrostomy

A procedure that creates a drainage path from the kidney through the skin when urine cannot pass normally to the bladder. A temporary tube usually carries urine into a bag while the blockage is treated.

Nephrostomy Tube

A drainage tube passed through the skin into the kidney to carry urine into a bag when the ureter is blocked. Blockage may be caused by a stone, tumor, or narrowing. Infection with blockage can lead to sepsis and is treated with drainage; the tube may be temporary or long-term.

Nephrotic Range Proteinuria

Very large protein loss in the urine, usually more than 3.5 grams per day in an adult. It often indicates serious damage to the kidney filters and can cause swelling, low blood protein, high cholesterol, blood clots, or infection.

Nephrotic Syndrome

A kidney disorder caused by damage to the tiny clusters of blood vessels (glomeruli) that filter waste and excess water from the blood. The damaged filters allow excessive amounts of protein to spill from the bloodstream into the urine. This loss of vital blood proteins leads to widespread swelling (edema), particularly around the eyes and in the feet and ankles, along with low levels of albumin in the blood and high levels of blood cholesterol.

Nephrotoxic

Describing a substance or condition that can damage the kidneys or reduce their function. Examples include some medicines, poisons, infections, and severe dehydration; risk depends on dose, duration, and kidney health.

Nephrotoxicity

Kidney injury or impaired kidney function caused by a medicine, poison, contrast agent, or other exposure. It may present as an acute rise in serum creatinine, reduced urine output, or tubular, interstitial, or glomerular damage. The pattern and severity depend on the agent, exposure, and underlying kidney function.

Nernst Equation

A formula for calculating the equilibrium electrical potential for a single ion across a membrane from its concentration or activity on each side, ion charge, and absolute temperature. At this potential, the electrical and chemical forces on that ion balance, so there is no net movement of that ion across the membrane.

Nerve

A bundle of nerve fibers that carries messages between the brain or spinal cord and the rest of the body. Nerves control movement and carry sensations such as touch, pain, and temperature.

Nerve Biopsy

Removal of a small piece of a nerve for laboratory examination when serious nerve disease is suspected. It may help identify inflammation, infection, abnormal deposits, or a tumor, but can leave permanent numbness or weakness near the biopsy site.

Nerve Block

An injection of numbing medicine near a nerve or group of nerves to temporarily stop pain signals. It may help diagnose the source of pain or provide pain relief during or after a procedure; weakness or other temporary effects can occur.

Nerve Compression

Alternate name; see *Pinched Nerve*.

Nerve Conduction Studies

Tests that stimulate peripheral nerves with small electrical pulses and record how quickly and strongly signals travel. They help identify nerve damage, compression, loss of the nerve's insulating covering,

or loss of nerve fibers.

Nerve Conduction Study

A test that gives small electrical pulses to a nerve and measures how quickly and strongly the signal travels. It helps identify nerve damage, pressure on a nerve, or loss of its protective covering.

Nerve Conduction Velocity

The speed at which an electrical signal travels along a peripheral nerve. A nerve-conduction test measures this speed and the signal strength to help identify nerve damage, pressure on a nerve, or damage to its insulating covering.

Nerve Deafness

Hearing loss caused by damage to the cochlea, auditory nerve, or central auditory pathways rather than blockage of sound transmission through the outer or middle ear.

Alternate Names:
Sensorineural Hearing Loss; SNHL

Nerve Endings

The tiny ends of nerves that detect sensations such as touch, pain, heat, or pressure, or release signals to muscles and glands. Injury or irritation can cause pain, numbness, tingling, or abnormal sweating.

Nerve Fiber

The long, thread-like part of a nerve cell that carries signals. Most nerve fibers are axons, sometimes covered by a fatty insulating layer called myelin.

Nerve Fiber Types

A classification of peripheral nerve axons by diameter, myelination, and conduction speed. Group A fibers are myelinated and include fast motor and sensory fibers; group B fibers are thinly myelinated preganglionic autonomic fibers; group C fibers are unmyelinated and conduct slowly, including many fibers for pain, temperature, and postganglionic autonomic signals.

Nerve Impulse

An electrical signal that travels along a nerve cell or nerve fiber to carry information.

Nerve Injury

Damage to a nerve that can cause pain, numbness, tingling, weakness, altered reflexes, or changes in sweating, blood pressure, digestion, or bladder function. Recovery depends on the nerve, severity, cause, and treatment.

Nerve Plexus

A network where nerves join and branch to supply a body region. The brachial plexus, for example, supplies much of the arm.

Nerve Repair

Surgical reconstruction of an injured or divided peripheral nerve using direct repair, a nerve graft, a nerve conduit, or nerve transfer. The aim is to restore continuity and support recovery of sensation or movement, although recovery depends on the injury and timing.

Nerve Root

The beginning part of a spinal nerve where it connects with the spinal cord. Sensory and motor roots carry signals into and out of the cord.

Nerve Sheath Myxoma

A benign myxoid peripheral-nerve-sheath tumor, usually presenting as a slow-growing papule or nodule on the fingers, hands, or upper extremities.

Nerve Sparing

A surgical approach that tries to preserve nearby nerves needed for erection, sensation, or other functions. It may improve recovery after prostate or other pelvic surgery, but success depends on disease and nerve involvement.

Nerve Thickening

Enlargement of a nerve that a health professional can feel or see during an exam. It can occur in leprosy, especially when the affected nerve also causes

loss of feeling or muscle weakness.

Nerve Tract

A group of nerve fibers traveling together inside the brain or spinal cord. Fibers in a tract carry signals between specific regions, so damage can cause predictable movement, sensation, or organ-control problems.

Nervous Colon Syndrome

An older name for irritable bowel syndrome, a disorder causing recurrent abdominal pain with diarrhea, constipation, or both without a structural explanation. Symptoms may improve with individualized diet, medicines, and stress management.

Nervous System

The brain and spinal cord (central nervous system), peripheral nerves and ganglia (peripheral nervous system), and supporting cells that detect and process information. It coordinates sensation, movement, automatic body functions, cognition, emotion, learning, and behavior.

Nervous Tissue

Tissue made of nerve cells and supporting cells that detects changes, processes information, and sends signals through the body. It forms the brain, spinal cord, and nerves and helps control movement, sensation, and organ function.

Nesidioblastosis

A rare diffuse or focal hyperfunctional hypertrophy and hyperplasia of pancreatic beta cells budding from the pancreatic ductal epithelium, causing endogenous persistent hyperinsulinemic hypoglycemia in neonates (congenital hyperinsulinism) and adults (post-gastric bypass hyperinsulinemic hypoglycemia).

NET

Abbreviation; see *Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Netherton Syndrome

A severe autosomal recessive genodermatosis caused by mutations in the SPINK5 gene encoding the serine protease inhibitor LEKTI, characterized by the classic triad of congenital ichthyosiform erythroderma (ichthyosis linearis circumflexa), trichorrhexis invaginata ('bamboo hair'), and severe atopic diathesis.

Nettle Rash

An itchy rash made of raised patches that come and go, often within hours. It results from substances released in the skin and may be triggered by infection, foods, medicines, pressure, heat, or no clear cause.

Neural

Relating to nerves, nerve cells, or the nervous system. In pregnancy, the neural tube develops into the brain and spinal cord; failure of it to close can cause birth defects such as spina bifida or anencephaly.

Neural Crest

A temporary embryonic multipotent cellular population located along the borders of the closing neural folds that undergoes epithelial-to-mesenchymal transition and migrates extensively to form peripheral sensory ganglia, autonomic ganglia, Schwann cells, melanocytes, craniofacial bones, and adrenal chromaffin cells.

Neuralgia

Neuralgia is sharp, burning, or electric pain along the distribution of a nerve, caused by irritation, compression, infection, injury, or other disease.

Neuralgia Amyotrophica

Another name for neuralgic amyotrophy (Parsonage-Turner syndrome), a disorder usually involving the brachial plexus. It typically begins with sudden severe shoulder or upper-arm pain, followed over days or weeks by patchy weakness and sometimes muscle wasting. The cause is often unknown; immune, infectious, and other triggers have been proposed.

Alternate Names:
Parsonage-Turner Syndrome; Neuralgic Amyotrophy

Neural Pathway

A connected route of nerve cells and nerve fibers that carries signals between different parts of the nervous system.

Neural Tube Defect

A congenital structural anomaly resulting from incomplete closure of the embryonic neural tube during early pregnancy; see *Neural Tube Defects*.

Neural Tube Defects

Birth defects caused when the early structure that becomes the brain and spinal cord does not close completely during the first month of pregnancy. They include anencephaly, encephalocele, and spina bifida and vary from fatal to mild.

Neuraminidase Inhibitors

Antiviral medicines that block a surface protein used by influenza viruses to release new virus particles from infected cells. They work best when started early and are used according to the influenza type, illness severity, and risk of complications.

Neurapraxia

The mildest category of peripheral nerve injury in the Seddon classification, involving a temporary block of nerve-signal conduction, usually from focal myelin injury or ischemia without axon disruption. Recovery is generally good and often occurs over weeks to a few months, though timing varies with the injury.

Neurilemma

The outer layer of a Schwann cell that surrounds and supports a nerve fiber outside the brain and spinal cord.

Neurilemmoma

Alternate spelling; see *Schwannoma*.

Neurinomatosis

Alternate name; see *Schwannomatosis*.

Neuritic Plaques

Clusters of beta-amyloid surrounded by damaged nerve-cell branches. They are one brain change associated with Alzheimer disease and occur alongside other changes, including abnormal tau protein and loss of nerve cells.

Neuritis

Inflammation or irritation of a nerve, often causing pain, altered sensation, weakness, or other changes in nerve function.

Neuroacanthocytosis

A group of rare inherited disorders causing movement or psychiatric symptoms together with abnormal spiny red blood cells called acanthocytes. Neurologic and genetic findings help distinguish the disorders in this group.

Neuroanatomy

The study of the structure and organization of the nervous system, including the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and their connections.

Neuroblastoma

A childhood cancer arising from immature nerve cells, commonly in or near the adrenal glands or spine. It may cause an abdominal mass, pain, weakness, or other symptoms and can range from mild to aggressive.

Alternate Names:
Sympathicoblastoma

Neurocardiogenic Syncope

Alternate name; see *Vasovagal Syncope*.

Neurocognitive Disorder

A decline from a person's previous level of cognitive ability, such as memory, attention, language, executive function, or judgment, that develops after normal earlier development. Mild neurocognitive disorder causes modest decline while independence is largely preserved; major neurocognitive disorder causes substantial decline that interferes with independent daily life and is often called demen-

tia. Causes include brain disease, stroke, injury, infection, substance use, or medicines. Delirium is distinguished by its sudden onset and fluctuating attention and awareness.

Neurocognitive Disorders

Alternate plural form; see *Neurocognitive Disorder*.

Neurocutaneous Syndrome

A disorder affecting both the nervous system and the skin, often because of an inherited genetic change. Examples include neurofibromatosis and tuberous sclerosis.

Neurocutaneous Syndromes Pathology

Pathologic features of inherited disorders affecting the skin, nervous system, eyes, and sometimes other organs. Findings vary by syndrome and may include hamartomas, vascular malformations, neural tumors, or characteristic pigmentary lesions.

Neurocysticercosis

Infection of the brain or spinal cord by larvae of the pork tapeworm, *Taenia solium*. It develops when a person swallows the tapeworm's eggs, usually through food, water, or hands contaminated with the feces of someone carrying the adult tapeworm; eating undercooked pork causes intestinal tapeworm infection, not neurocysticercosis directly. Symptoms depend on where and how many cysts form and commonly include seizures or headaches; confusion, weakness, or fluid buildup in the brain can also occur.

Neurocytoma

A usually slow-growing tumor made of nerve-cell-like cells, most often found in the fluid-filled spaces inside the brain. It may block fluid flow and cause headache, vomiting, vision changes, or balance problems; imaging and tissue testing guide care.

Neurodegeneration

Progressive damage and loss of nerve cells, causing worsening problems with movement, memory, thinking, sensation, or other nervous-system functions.

Neurodegeneration With Brain Iron Accumulation

A group of inherited disorders in which excess iron builds up in certain brain regions and gradually damages nerve cells. Symptoms may include abnormal movements, muscle stiffness, seizures, speech or thinking problems, and vision changes.

Neurodegenerative Disease

A disease in which nerve cells progressively lose function or die. Examples include Alzheimer disease, Parkinson disease, and Huntington disease.

Neurodegenerative Disorder

Another term for a condition involving progressive damage or loss of nerve cells, which can affect movement, memory, behavior, sensation, or autonomic function.

Neurodermatitis

A chronic itchy skin condition in which repeated scratching or rubbing makes a patch thick, leathery, and irritated. Stress, dry skin, or an initial rash may start the itch–scratch cycle.

Alternate Names:
Lichen Simplex Chronicus; Circumscribed Neurodermatitis

Neurodevelopmental Disabilities

Disabilities that begin during development and affect one or more areas such as movement, communication, learning, behavior, or adaptive functioning. They may result from genetic, prenatal, birth-related, or early-life causes and vary in severity and support needs.

Neurodevelopmental Disorders

A group of conditions that begin during the developmental period and affect cognition, communication, behavior, motor function, learning, or adaptive skills. Examples include attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder, autism spectrum disorder, intellectual disability, communication disorders, specific learning disorder, motor disorders, and tic disorders.

Neuroendocrine

Relating to the connection between the nervous system and hormone system, or to cells that receive nerve signals and can release hormones. Neuroendocrine cells are found in many organs and can sometimes form tumors.

Neuroendocrine Carcinoma

A cancer arising from cells with nerve-like and hormone-related features. It can begin in the lung or digestive system, often grows quickly, and may release hormones that cause additional symptoms.

Neuroendocrine Carcinoma of the Skin

Alternate name; see *Merkel Cell Carcinoma*.

Neuroendocrine Tumor

A diverse group of neoplasms that arise from specialized neuroendocrine cells, which have traits of both nerve cells and hormone-producing endocrine cells. These tumors most frequently develop in the digestive tract, lungs, or pancreas. Because they can produce and release hormones directly into the bloodstream, they may cause distinct symptoms such as severe flushing, diarrhea, wheezing, or blood sugar fluctuations, though many grow slowly without producing noticeable hormone-related symptoms.

Alternate Names:
NET; Carcinoid Tumor

Neuroendocrine Tumor Grading

Classification of a neuroendocrine tumor based on how quickly its cells divide, assessed by the Ki-67 index and mitotic count. Higher grades generally indicate faster cell growth, although behavior also depends on tumor type and site.

Neuroendocrine Tumors

Plural form; see *Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Alternate Names:
NETs; Neuroendocrine Neoplasms

Neuroendocrinology

The medical field that studies how the brain and nerves control hormones and how hormones affect the nervous system. It includes conditions involving the pituitary, adrenal glands, thyroid, reproduction, growth, and body-fluid balance.

Neurofibrillary Tangles

Twisted clumps of an abnormal protein called tau inside nerve cells. They damage the cells and are a characteristic finding in Alzheimer disease and some other disorders that cause progressive memory or thinking problems.

Alternate Names:
Paired Helical Filaments; Tau Tangles

Neurofibroma

A benign peripheral nerve sheath tumor. Solitary neurofibromas are common and present as soft, flesh-colored papules or nodules. Multiple neurofibromas are characteristic of neurofibromatosis type 1 (NF1).

Neurofibromatosis

A group of inherited tumor-predisposition disorders involving nerve-associated tissues. The term traditionally includes neurofibromatosis type 1 and the condition now called NF2-related schwannomatosis; current classification also recognizes other schwannomatoses. Features vary by subtype and may include skin findings, nerve-sheath tumors, bone changes, or central nervous-system tumors.

Neurofibromatosis-1

An inherited condition that can cause light-brown skin patches, freckles in the armpits or groin, soft growths along nerves, bone changes, vision problems, learning difficulties, or blood-vessel complications. Findings vary widely between people.

Neurofibromatosis 2

An older name for NF2-related schwannomatosis, a tumor-predisposition disorder associated with pathogenic variants in *NF2*. It is characterized especially by bilateral vestibular schwannomas and may also involve other schwannomas, meningiomas, or ependymomas. Current terminology distinguishes it from other schwannomatoses.

Neurofibromatosis Type 1

A genetic disorder that causes benign tumors to grow along nerves in the skin, brain, and other parts of the body. It is caused by a change in the *NF1* gene, which normally helps control cell growth. Common signs include flat, light-brown skin patches (café-au-lait spots), freckling in the armpits or groin, tiny harmless bumps on the iris of the eye (Lisch nodules), and soft non-cancerous skin tumors (neurofibromas), as well as bone differences or learning challenges.

Alternate Names:
NF1; Von Recklinghausen Disease

Neurofibromatosis Type 2

Alternate name; see *NF2-Related Schwannomatosis*.

Alternate Names:
NF2; Bilateral Acoustic Neurofibromatosis (historical term)

Neurofibromatosis Type I

Alternate spelling; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

Neurofibromatosis Type II

Alternate name; see *NF2-Related Schwannomatosis*.

Neurofibrosarcoma

Alternate name; see *Malignant Peripheral Nerve Sheath Tumor*.

Neurogenesis

The formation of new nerve cells. It happens mainly before birth but can continue in limited areas of the adult brain.

Neurogenic

Caused by, arising from, or related to the nervous system. For example, neurogenic bladder results from nerve damage that disrupts bladder storage or emptying. The specific symptoms and treatment depend on which nerves are affected.

Neurogenic Bladder

Bladder problems caused by damage to the nerves that control storing or passing urine. A person may have urgency, leakage, difficulty emptying, or urine retention; repeated infection and high bladder pressure can damage the kidneys.

Neurogenic Claudication

Pain, heaviness, weakness, or numbness in the buttocks or legs that occurs with standing or walking and often improves with sitting or bending forward. It commonly results from narrowing around nerves in the lower spine; symptoms may affect one or both legs.

Alternate Names:
Pseudoclaudication; Spinal Stenosis Claudication

Neurogenic Megacolon

Severe widening of the large intestine caused by damage to the nerves that control bowel movement. It can cause long-term constipation, abdominal swelling, and stool blockage and may lead to dangerous bowel inflammation or rupture.

Neurogenic Orthostatic Hypotension

A drop in blood pressure after standing because nerve damage prevents the body from tightening its blood vessels and maintaining pressure. It may cause light-headedness, blurred vision, weakness, fainting, or falls.

Neurogenic Pulmonary Edema

Rapid-onset, non-cardiogenic pulmonary edema developing acutely after severe central nervous system insults (such as massive subarachnoid hemorrhage, head trauma, or status epilepticus), provoked by an intense sympathetic surge that induces sudden pulmonary vasoconstriction and capillary leak.

Alternate Names:
NPE

Neurogenic Shock

A type of distributive shock, usually caused by a high spinal-cord injury that disrupts sympathetic nerve signals. Blood vessels widen, causing low blood pressure; the heart rate may also be slow, and the skin may feel warm. It is distinct from spinal shock, which is a temporary loss of reflexes and other spinal-cord functions.

Neuroglia

Supporting cells of the nervous system that nourish, protect, insulate, and maintain nerve cells. Different types help control the nerve environment, form protective coverings, remove waste, and respond to injury or infection.

Neurography

An MRI method that produces detailed pictures of nerves outside the brain and spinal cord. It can help assess trapped, injured, inflamed, or enlarged nerves and may help find some nerve tumors.

Neurohypophysis

The back part of the pituitary gland that stores and releases oxytocin and vasopressin. These hormones help control childbirth, milk release, water balance, and urine concentration.

Neuroimmunology

The study of interactions between the nervous system and the immune system. It includes immune-related diseases of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, and muscles and the effects of inflammation on neural function.

Neuroinvasive Disease

An infection in which a pathogen, most commonly a virus, crosses into the central nervous system to infect the brain, spinal cord, or surrounding membranes. It typically manifests as meningitis, encephalitis, or acute flaccid paralysis, with symptoms including high fever, severe headache, neck stiffness, confusion, and muscle weakness.

Alternate Names:
Neuroinvasive Infection; Central Nervous System Invasion

Neurolathyrism

A toxic neurologic disorder caused by excessive consumption of Lathyrus sativus, producing progressive spastic weakness of the legs.

Neuroleptic

An older term for an antipsychotic medicine, used to treat conditions such as schizophrenia, severe mania, or psychosis. The term remains in names such as neuroleptic malignant syndrome; these medicines may cause sleepiness, movement problems, or metabolic effects.

Neuroleptic Agents

Antipsychotic medicines used for conditions such as schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, severe agitation, or nausea, depending on the drug. They can cause movement, metabolic, heart-rhythm, and sedation-related effects.

Alternate Names:
Antipsychotics

Neuroleptic Agent Toxicity

Overdose or adverse effects from an antipsychotic or other dopamine-blocking agent, causing sedation, hypotension, anticholinergic effects, seizures, QT prolongation, or other dysrhythmias. Neuroleptic malignant syndrome is a distinct delayed reaction with hyperthermia and rigidity; ECG, airway, temperature, and neurologic monitoring guide supportive treatment.

Neuroleptic Malignant Syndrome

A rare, life-threatening reaction to medications that block dopamine receptors in the brain, most commonly antipsychotic medications. The condition causes severe muscle rigidity (often described as "lead-pipe" stiffness), an abrupt and dangerous spike in body temperature, altered mental status, and severe instability of the autonomic nervous system, resulting in rapid heart rate and fluctuating blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
NMS

Neurological

Related to the brain, spinal cord, or nerves. Neurological symptoms may include weakness, numbness, seizures, headache, dizziness, confusion, or problems with movement, speech, vision, or memory.

Neurological Disease

Any disease affecting the brain, spinal cord, periph-

eral nerves, muscles, or their connections. Symptoms may include weakness, numbness, seizures, headache, movement changes, or problems with thinking.

Neurological Examination

A clinical assessment of mental status, cranial nerves, motor function, reflexes, coordination, sensation, and gait. It helps localize nervous-system dysfunction and determine the need for further testing.

Neurological Rehabilitation

Treatment and training that help a person regain movement, communication, thinking, or independence after stroke, brain or spinal-cord injury, Parkinson disease, multiple sclerosis, or another nervous-system disorder.

Neurologic Deficit

Loss or impairment of a neurologic function, such as strength, sensation, coordination, vision, language, or consciousness, caused by dysfunction of the nervous system.

Neurologic Disorders

A group of conditions affecting the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, neuromuscular junction, or muscles. Examples include stroke, epilepsy, migraine, multiple sclerosis, Parkinson disease, Alzheimer disease, peripheral neuropathy, meningitis, neuromuscular disorders, and movement disorders.

Neurologic Localization

Using the pattern of weakness, numbness, reflex changes, coordination problems, vision, speech, or thinking changes to identify where the nervous system is affected. This helps clinicians choose likely causes and appropriate tests.

Neurologist

A medical doctor who diagnoses and treats disorders of the brain, spinal cord, nerves, and muscles. Neurologists assess symptoms such as weakness, numbness, seizures, tremor, headaches, memory change, and movement or balance problems.

Neurology

The medical specialty concerned with diseases of the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and muscles.

Neurology PET

PET imaging used in selected neurologic disorders to assess brain metabolism or receptor activity, such as in some dementias, epilepsy evaluations, and movement disorders.

Neurolysis

A procedure that frees a nerve from scar tissue or pressure, or deliberately interrupts selected nerve fibers to relieve pain. The purpose and possible effects depend on the nerve treated and the technique used.

Neuroma

A benign growth or reactive thickening involving nerve tissue, often producing pain or altered sensation.

Neuromodulation

Changing nerve activity with electrical, magnetic, chemical, or other signals. Treatments include spinal cord stimulation, deep brain stimulation, and some noninvasive brain-stimulation methods.

Neuromuscular

Relating to nerves, muscles, or the place where a nerve tells a muscle to contract. Neuromuscular diseases can cause weakness, tiredness with activity, muscle wasting, cramps, or problems with breathing or swallowing.

Neuromuscular Blockade Reversal

The pharmacological restoration of normal neuromuscular transmission following surgical paralysis, achieved by administering an acetylcholinesterase inhibitor paired with an anticholinergic (neostigmine and glycopyrrolate) or a selective encapsulating reversal agent (sugammadex for rocuronium/vecuronium).

Neuromuscular Blocking Agents

Medicines used during anesthesia to temporarily relax skeletal muscles, making insertion of a breathing tube and some operations easier. They stop muscle movement but do not provide pain relief or unconsciousness and require breathing support and monitoring.

Neuromuscular Disorders

A group of conditions affecting motor nerves, neuromuscular junctions, or skeletal muscles. Examples include myasthenia gravis, Lambert-Eaton syndrome, muscular dystrophy, spinal muscular atrophy, motor neuron disease, inflammatory myositis, myopathies, and peripheral neuropathies.

Neuromuscular Hamartoma

A rare benign developmental lesion in which mature skeletal muscle and nerve fascicles are intermixed, typically involving a major peripheral nerve and causing enlargement or neuropathic symptoms.

Neuromuscular Junction

The small connection where a movement-controlling nerve communicates with a skeletal muscle. The nerve releases a chemical messenger there, causing the muscle to contract.

Alternate Names:
NMJ; Motor End-Plate

Neuromuscular Medicine

A neurology subspecialty concerned with disorders of peripheral nerves, neuromuscular junctions, and skeletal muscles. It uses clinical assessment and tests such as electromyography and nerve-conduction studies to diagnose and characterize weakness, sensory loss, muscle disease, and related conditions.

Neuromyelitis Optica

An older name, often used for neuromyelitis optica spectrum disorder (NMOSD), an autoimmune inflammatory disease of the optic nerves, spinal cord, and selected brain regions. Optic neuritis and longitudinally extensive myelitis are characteristic manifestations. Current usage distinguishes NMOSD from multiple sclerosis and related disorders.

Neuromyelitis Optica Spectrum Disorder

An autoimmune inflammatory disorder of the central nervous system, commonly associated with antibodies to aquaporin-4; some patients meet diagnostic criteria without detectable antibodies. It affects the optic nerves, spinal cord, or specific brain regions and can cause optic neuritis, myelitis, or area-postrema symptoms. It is distinct from multiple sclerosis and MOG-antibody-associated disease.

Alternate Names:
Neuromyelitis Optica NMO NMOSD Devic Disease Devic's Disease

Neuromyotonia

A rare disorder in which nerves repeatedly stimulate muscles, causing ongoing stiffness, twitching, cramps, delayed muscle relaxation, and sometimes excessive sweating. It may be inherited or caused by an immune reaction. An electrical nerve and muscle test helps diagnosis; treatment aims to calm nerve activity and address any underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Isaacs Syndrome; Continuous Muscle Fiber Activity Syndrome

Neuron

The fundamental nerve cell that serves as the basic building block of the nervous system, responsible for transmitting information throughout the brain, spinal cord, and body. A typical neuron consists of a cell body containing the nucleus, branch-like dendrites that receive incoming electrical and chemical signals from other neurons, and a long slender fiber called an axon that carries electrical impulses outward toward target cells or neighboring neurons.

Neuronal Ceroid Lipofuscinoses

A group of inherited disorders in which waste material builds up inside nerve cells. They usually cause worsening seizures, vision loss, movement problems, and difficulty thinking or learning, with symptoms and age of onset varying by type.

Neuronal Migration Disorder

A developmental brain disorder in which nerve cells do not move to their normal positions before birth.

It can cause abnormal brain structure, seizures, developmental delay, or learning problems.

Neurone

The British spelling of neuron, an excitable nerve cell that receives and transmits signals.

Neuronopathy

A disorder caused mainly by damage to nerve-cell bodies, often in sensory or motor nerve groups. It may cause numbness, imbalance, weakness, or loss of reflexes.

Neurons

Plural form; see *Neuron*.

Neuron-Specific Enolase

A protein that can be released by nerve cells and some neuroendocrine tumors. A raised blood level may support evaluation or monitoring in selected situations but is not specific enough to diagnose a disease alone.

Neuron-Specific Enolase Tumor Marker

Neuron-specific enolase, a protein that may be increased in some neuroendocrine cancers or after nerve-cell injury. It can support monitoring in selected situations but is not specific enough to diagnose cancer alone.

Neuro-Oncology

The subspecialty concerned with tumors of the nervous system and their neurologic effects. It includes primary brain and spinal cord tumors and tumors that spread to the nervous system. It also addresses neurologic complications of cancer or its treatment.

Neuro-Ophthalmology

The clinical subspecialty at the intersection of neurology and ophthalmology, concerned with visual problems caused by the brain, optic nerves, or visual pathways. It also evaluates disorders of the pupils and eye movements and helps distinguish neurologic causes of visual dysfunction from disease within the eye itself.

Neuropathic

Caused by disease or dysfunction of nerves; neuropathic skin symptoms may include burning, electric-shock pain, altered sensation, numbness, or itch.

Neuropathic Pain

Pain caused by disease or injury of the nerves that carry sensation, the spinal cord, or the brain. It is often burning, shooting, electric, or accompanied by numbness and may follow diabetes, shingles, injury, or nerve compression.

Neuropathic Ulcer

A wound caused or worsened by loss of protective feeling, most often in the foot. A person may not notice pressure or injury, allowing the wound to deepen; diabetes, poor circulation, and infection can delay healing and increase the risk of amputation.

Neuropathy

Damage or disease affecting one or more nerves outside the brain and spinal cord. It can cause pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, balance problems, or changes in sweating and other body functions. Causes include diabetes, nerve injury or pressure, some medicines, alcohol or other toxins, vitamin deficiencies, and inherited disorders such as Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease.

Neuropeptide

A small protein-like molecule produced and released by neurons in the brain and nervous system to transmit and modulate communication between nerve cells. Unlike rapid neurotransmitters that act instantly across narrow synapses, neuropeptides often act more slowly and over wider areas to influence long-term neural functions, including pain sensation (such as endorphins), appetite, mood, and stress responses.

Neuropeptides

Plural form; see *Neuropeptide*.

Neuropharmacology

The study of how medicines and other substances affect the brain, spinal cord, and nerves. It exam-

ines their actions, benefits, side effects, interactions, and uses in treating neurological or psychiatric conditions.

Neurophysiology

The study of how the nervous system functions, including electrical signaling, sensory processing, movement, reflexes, and communication between nerve cells. Clinical neurophysiology uses tests such as EEG and nerve-conduction studies to assess nervous-system function.

Neurophysiotherapy

Physical therapy focused on movement and function problems caused by disorders of the brain, spinal cord, or nerves. Treatment may address strength, balance, walking, coordination, and daily activities.

Neuroplasticity

The brain's ability to change its connections and activity in response to learning, experience, or injury. This process supports recovery and skill development, especially with repeated practice and rehabilitation, but recovery varies with the injury and the person.

Neuroplegic

Causing paralysis or severe loss of nerve-controlled movement. The effect may result from a neurologic disease, spinal injury, toxin, or medicine and can impair breathing or other vital functions when major nerve pathways are affected.

Neuropsychiatry

The clinical field concerned with mental, behavioral, and cognitive problems associated with disorders of the brain and nervous system. It considers how neurologic disease can affect mood, perception, memory, and behavior, and how psychiatric symptoms can overlap with neurologic conditions.

Neuropsychopharmacology

The study of how medicines and other substances alter brain function and behavior, especially in neurological and psychiatric disorders. It links drug actions on neural systems with therapeutic effects and adverse effects.

Neuroradiology

The radiology subspecialty that uses and interprets imaging of the brain, spine, head, and neck. Modalities include computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and vascular imaging; findings help diagnose neurologic, neurosurgical, and head-and-neck disorders.

Neuroretinitis

Inflammation of the optic nerve and nearby retina that can cause blurred or reduced vision, blind spots, and pain with eye movement. Infections and immune disorders are possible causes; diagnosis and treatment depend on the underlying cause.

Neurosarcoidosis

Sarcoidosis affecting the brain, spinal cord, coverings around them, or peripheral nerves. It may cause headaches, facial weakness, vision problems, seizures, weakness, numbness, or hormone disturbances; treatment varies with the affected nervous-system structures.

Neuroscience

The comprehensive, interdisciplinary scientific domain dedicated to the systematic investigation of the nervous system—encompassing the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and sensory organs—across all levels of organization, from molecular and cellular neurobiology to neuroanatomy, neurophysiology, neural circuitry, computational neuroscience, behavioral neurology, and clinical neuropharmacology. It examines the mechanisms of neuronal excitability, synaptic transmission, neurodevelopment, cognitive processing, sensory perception, motor control, memory formation, neuroplasticity, and the pathophysiological underpinnings of neurological and psychiatric diseases (e.g., neurodegenerative disorders, stroke, epilepsy, schizophrenia).

Neurosciences

Plural form; see *Neuroscience*.

Neurosurgeon

A surgeon trained to diagnose and operate on disorders of the brain, spinal cord, spine, nerves, and nearby supporting structures. Neurosurgeons may treat tumors, injuries, bleeding, pressure, pain, or blood-vessel problems.

Neurosurgery

Surgery for disorders of the brain, spinal cord, spine, peripheral nerves, or supporting structures. Procedures may remove tumors, relieve pressure, repair injuries, stop bleeding, treat blood vessels, or improve severe pain.

Neurosyphilis

Infection of the central nervous system by *Treponema pallidum*, which can occur at any stage of syphilis. Manifestations include meningitis, cranial-nerve dysfunction, stroke, motor or sensory deficits, cognitive changes, and late forms such as tabes dorsalis or general paresis. Diagnosis combines clinical findings and syphilis serology; cerebrospinal-fluid testing is used when neurologic involvement is suspected. Ocular or ear syphilis may occur alone or with neurosyphilis.

Neurotoxicity

Injury or dysfunction of the nervous system caused by a medicine, drug, toxin, heavy metal, infection, or other harmful exposure.

Neurotransmission

The process by which nerve cells communicate with one another or with muscles and glands using electrical signals and chemical messengers. It involves release of a neurotransmitter, movement across a synapse, receptor binding, and termination or removal of the signal.

Neurotransmitter

A chemical messenger released by a nerve cell. It crosses a tiny gap to affect another nerve cell or a muscle or gland cell, either increasing or reducing its activity.

Neurotransmitter Receptors

Proteins on or inside cells that receive chemical messages released by nerve cells. When a message attaches to a receptor, it can increase or decrease activity, affecting movement, mood, pain, heart rate, or other body functions.

Neurotrophic

Describing a substance or effect that supports the growth, survival, connection, or repair of nerve cells. Neurotrophic signals help nerves develop and maintain function and are studied in nerve injury and degenerative disease.

Neurotrophic Keratopathy

Corneal damage caused by reduced sensation from injury or disease of the trigeminal nerve. It can lead to poor healing, recurrent epithelial defects, ulceration, and vision loss, sometimes with little pain.

Neurotropic

Having a preference for nervous tissue or mainly affecting the brain, spinal cord, or nerves. The term is often used for infections, medicines, or other substances that act in these tissues.

Neurovascular Examination

A check of movement, feeling, pulses, skin color, temperature, and blood return in an injured arm or leg. Repeated checks can detect worsening nerve damage, reduced blood flow, or dangerous swelling and pressure.

Neutral Alignment

A posture in which the body is arranged in a straight, balanced line while preserving normal spinal curves.

Neutral Endopeptidase

A membrane-bound zinc metallopeptidase expressed in vascular endothelial and renal proximal tubular cells that degrades circulating natriuretic peptides (ANP, BNP, CNP), bradykinin, and substance P; pharmacologically inhibited by sacubitril in heart failure therapy.

Alternate Names:
Neprilysin; NEP; CD10

Neutralization

Removal or reduction of an effect by counteraction, such as an acid-base reaction or antibody-antigen binding.

Neutralizing Antibodies

Antibodies that bind a pathogen or its toxin and block its ability to enter cells, attach to tissues, or cause its usual biologic effects.

Neutropenia

An abnormally low number of neutrophils, white blood cells that help fight bacterial and fungal infections. The lower the count, the greater the infection risk; fever during severe neutropenia can signal a serious infection.

Alternate Names:
Neutrocytopenia; Low Absolute Neutrophil Count

Neutropenic Enterocolitis

A life-threatening, necrotizing transmural inflammation of the cecum and ascending colon occurring in severely neutropenic oncology patients receiving intensive myelosuppressive chemotherapy, presenting with fever, right lower quadrant abdominal pain, and bowel wall thickening on CT.

Alternate Names:
Typhlitis

Neutropenic Fever

Alternate name; see *Febrile Neutropenia*.

Alternate Names:
Febrile Neutropenia

Neutropenic Sepsis

Sepsis occurring in a person with a markedly reduced neutrophil count, usually during or after cancer treatment. Infection may produce few localizing signs, while fever, chills, low blood pressure, altered mental status, or organ dysfunction can occur; the severity reflects both infection and impaired host defense.

Neutrophil

The most common type of white blood cell in the bloodstream, serving as the immune system's primary first responders against acute infections, especially those caused by bacteria and fungi. Produced in the bone marrow, neutrophils travel rapidly to sites of infection or tissue injury, where they ingest and neutralize invading microorganisms using antimicrobial enzymes and chemical defenses.

Neutrophil Extracellular Traps

Web-like structures of DNA and proteins released by activated neutrophils that can trap microbes. Excessive formation may contribute to inflammation, blood clots, or autoimmune disease.

Alternate Names:
NETs

Neutrophilic Dermatosis

A group of inflammatory skin diseases in which infection-fighting white blood cells collect in the skin without causing a typical skin infection. Examples include Sweet syndrome and pyoderma gangrenosum; the rash may be painful, swollen, or associated with fever.

Neutrophilic Eccrine Hidradenitis

An uncommon skin inflammation in which infection-fighting white cells collect around sweat glands. It often occurs during chemotherapy and causes painful red or purple bumps or patches, usually on the trunk or limbs.

Neutrophil Recruitment

The movement of neutrophils from the bloodstream into injured or infected tissue. They first slow and attach to the blood-vessel lining, then pass through it and follow chemical signals to the affected area.

Neutrophils

Plural form; see *Neutrophil*.

Nevi

Plural of *Nevus*.

Nevi of Ota and Ito

Benign dermal melanocytic nevi causing blue-gray pigmentation around the eye and forehead in nevus of Ota or over the shoulder and upper back in nevus of Ito. They may persist for life; nevus of Ota can involve ocular tissues, and changing lesions may indicate atypia.

Nevoid Basal Cell Carcinoma Syndrome

Gorlin syndrome, an inherited disorder increasing the risk of basal-cell cancers, jaw cysts, and other developmental abnormalities.

Nevus

A localized, usually benign lesion of the skin or mucous membrane caused by a growth or developmental variation of pigment cells, blood vessels, or other tissue components. A melanocytic nevus is commonly called a mole; other nevi have different tissue origins.

Nevus Anemicus

A congenital vascular anomaly presenting as a localized, well-circumscribed, pale, hypopigmented macule or patch that remains pale after rubbing or temperature changes due to localized hypersensitivity of cutaneous alpha-adrenergic receptors producing constant arteriolar vasoconstriction.

Alternate Names:
Anemic Nevus; Pharmacologic Vasoconstrictive Nevus

Nevus Araneus (Spider Nevus)

A small central red vessel with radiating branches that blanch with pressure and refill from the center. It is common in children, pregnancy, and liver disease; numerous or new lesions can be associated with an underlying condition.

Nevus Comedonicus

A congenital hamartoma of the pilosebaceous unit presenting as a localised cluster of dilated follicular ostia filled with keratinous plugs, resembling closely grouped open comedones. It typically appears at birth or in early childhood on the face, neck, or trunk, and may be associated with other developmental anomalies.

Nevus Comedonicus Syndrome

A rare disorder in which multiple comedone-like skin lesions occur with abnormalities of the eyes, bones, nervous system, or other organs. It is usually present from birth or early childhood.

Nevus of Ito

A benign dermal melanocytic hamartoma characterized by mottled, patchy slate-gray, blue-brown, or hyperpigmented macules distributed along the sensory branches of the posterior supraclavicular and lateral cutaneous brachial nerves (involving the supraclavicular, acromial, and scapular regions).

Alternate Names:
Omohyoid Nevus; Dermal Melanocytosis of Shoulder

Nevus of Ota

A congenital or acquired dermal melanocytosis presenting as mottled blue-gray or brownish-black pigmentation in the distribution of the ophthalmic (V1) and maxillary (V2) branches of the trigeminal nerve, commonly involving the ipsilateral sclera, conjunctiva, and facial skin.

Alternate Names:
Oculodermal Melanocytosis; Nevus Fusco-Caeruleus Ophthalmomaxillaris

Nevus Sebaceus

A congenital or early-onset hamartoma of sebaceous and other adnexal structures, usually a yellow-orange hairless plaque on the scalp or face; secondary tumors may rarely arise within it.

Newborn

A baby during the first 28 days after birth, a period of rapid adaptation in breathing, circulation, feeding, and temperature regulation.

Newborn Circumcision

Surgical removal of the foreskin from a newborn's penis. Potential benefits and risks vary; complications can include bleeding, infection, or injury.

Decisions vary with the infant's health and the family's preferences.

Newborn Head Molding

Temporary shaping or overlapping of a newborn's skull bones during passage through the birth canal; it usually resolves as the skull returns to its normal contour.

Newborn Hearing Screen

A quick test, usually before discharge from the birth facility, that checks whether a newborn responds normally to sound. A result needing repeat testing does not by itself prove hearing loss; further testing clarifies hearing status.

Newborn Infant Development

The normal physical, neuromotor, sensory, and social milestone progression of a healthy full-term infant during the first month of life (neonatal period), including primitive reflexes (Moro, rooting, suckling, palmar grasp), visual tracking, auditory responsiveness, and weight recovery.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Development; Infant Milestone Progression; Newborn Neuromotor Development

Newborn Jaundice

Yellow discoloration of a newborn's skin or eyes caused by elevated bilirubin. Mild physiologic jaundice is common, while early, severe, rapidly rising, prolonged, or conjugated hyperbilirubinemia can signal an underlying disorder. Very high bilirubin can cause acute bilirubin encephalopathy and permanent neurologic injury called kernicterus.

Newborn Metabolic Screen

A blood-spot screening test performed shortly after birth to identify selected inherited metabolic and other disorders before symptoms appear. A heel-prick sample is commonly used; timing and the conditions included vary by screening program. An out-of-range result is not itself a diagnosis and requires confirmatory testing.

Newborn Screening

Testing shortly after birth for selected treatable genetic, metabolic, hormone, hearing, and heart conditions before symptoms appear. A small blood sample is usually taken from the heel; the conditions screened and timing vary by country or region.

Newborn Screening Panel

The set of conditions screened for in newborns by a regional or national public-health program. Blood-spot panels commonly include selected inherited metabolic, endocrine, and blood disorders; hearing and critical congenital heart disease are screened by separate methods. Panel contents and collection timing vary by jurisdiction, and a positive screen requires diagnostic confirmation.

Newborn Screening Tests

Tests performed shortly after birth to detect selected treatable genetic, endocrine, metabolic, hematologic, hearing, or critical congenital heart conditions before symptoms develop.

New Daily Persistent Headache

A headache that begins on a clearly remembered day and becomes continuous within 24 hours, persisting for at least three months. It may resemble migraine or tension-type headache; secondary causes include infection, pressure disorders, and vascular disease.

New York Heart Association Functional Classification

A standardized clinical grading scale assessing the severity of functional symptomatic limitation in patients with heart failure based on physical exertion, ranging from Class I (no symptoms with ordinary physical activity) to Class IV (symptoms present at rest).

Alternate Names:
NYHA Functional Classification; NYHA Class

Nexium

Brand name; see *Esomeprazole*.

Next-Generation Sequencing

A laboratory method that reads many DNA sections at the same time. It can examine selected genes, nearly all protein-coding genes, the whole genome, or tumor DNA; results may miss some changes and require expert interpretation.

Nexus

A general word for a connection or central link between medical structures, processes, or findings. It has no single standardized medical meaning; the specific relationship should be stated.

NF1

Abbreviation; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

NF2

Abbreviation; see *NF2-Related Schwannomatosis*.

NF2-Related Schwannomatosis

A genetic tumor-predisposition disorder, usually involving pathogenic variants in NF2, characterized by schwannomas, especially bilateral vestibular schwannomas, with possible hearing loss, tinnitus, balance problems, meningiomas, or other nerve tumors.

Niacin

Vitamin B3, needed to help cells release energy and perform many chemical reactions; it forms the coenzymes NAD+ and NADP+ that carry electrons in metabolism. Severe deficiency causes pellagra, with skin changes, digestive problems, confusion, weakness, and potentially life-threatening complications.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin B3; Nicotinic Acid

Niacinamide

The amide form of vitamin B3, used as a nutritional supplement and in selected dermatologic preparations. Unlike niacin, it usually does not cause flushing at nutritional doses.

Niacin Deficiency

A lack of vitamin B3, usually from inadequate intake of niacin or tryptophan, impaired absorption, or increased metabolic needs. Severe deficiency causes pellagra, classically involving photosensitive dermatitis, diarrhea, and neuropsychiatric changes. It can also occur with alcohol use disorder, malabsorption, or certain metabolic disorders.

Niacin For Cholesterol

Niacin lowers triglycerides and can raise HDL cholesterol, but its routine cardiovascular benefit is limited when added to effective statin therapy; flushing, liver injury, hyperglycaemia, and hyperuricaemia limit high-dose use.

Niacin Vitamin B3

Alternate name; see *Niacin*.

Nialamide

An older monoamine-oxidase-inhibitor antidepressant that is no longer commonly used.

Nicardipine

A calcium-channel-blocking medicine that relaxes blood vessels and lowers blood pressure. It is used for selected urgent or ongoing blood-pressure problems and may cause headache, flushing, dizziness, fast heartbeat, or swelling.

Nickel Allergy

An allergic skin reaction caused by contact with nickel-containing materials.

Alternate Names:
Nickel Hypersensitivity; Nickel Contact Dermatitis

Nickel-Chromium

A metal mixture used in some dental crowns and medical devices. It is strong and less costly than some alternatives, but people allergic to nickel may develop skin or mouth reactions after contact.

Niclosamide

An antiparasitic medicine used in some countries to treat selected intestinal tapeworm infections. It acts mainly in the gut and does not reliably treat larval tapeworm infections in tissues, such as neurocysticercosis.

Nicolau Syndrome

A rare injection-site injury marked by severe pain, a net-like red or purple discoloration, and sometimes skin or deeper-tissue death. It usually follows an intramuscular or other injection; the exact mechanism is uncertain but may involve vascular injury, spasm, or blockage.

Alternate Names:
Embolia Cutis Medicamentosa; Livedo-like Dermatitis

Nicotinamide

Alternate name; see *Niacinamide*.

Nicotinamide Adenine Dinucleotide

A molecule present in all living cells that helps transfer energy from food and supports enzymes involved in cell repair and communication. It exists in forms commonly written as NAD+ and NADH.

Nicotine

An addictive stimulant found in tobacco and some vaping products that acts on neuronal nicotinic receptors.

Nicotine Addiction

Alternate name; see *Nicotine Dependence*.

Nicotine And Tobacco

Nicotine poisoning can follow swallowing tobacco or liquid nicotine, breathing concentrated vapor, or skin contact. It may cause nausea, vomiting, sweating, dizziness, fast heartbeat, seizures, or breathing failure.

Nicotine Dependence

A pattern of compulsive nicotine use with cravings, loss of control, tolerance, and withdrawal symptoms when use is reduced or stopped.

Alternate Names:
Tobacco Use Disorder; Nicotine Addiction

Nicotine Poisoning

Nicotine poisoning causes early nausea, vomiting, salivation, dizziness, tachycardia, and agitation followed by weakness, bradycardia, seizures, or respiratory failure in severe exposure.

Nicotine Replacement Therapy

Nicotine medicines help reduce withdrawal when stopping tobacco. Using too much or combining products improperly can cause nausea, vomiting, dizziness, sweating, fast heartbeat, confusion, or seizures; keep them away from children.

Nicotine Withdrawal

Symptoms occurring after reducing or stopping nicotine, such as irritability, craving, anxiety, low mood, restlessness, poor concentration, increased appetite, and sleep disturbance. Symptoms usually improve with time and can be treated with behavioral and medication support.

Nicotinic

Relating to nicotine or to nicotinic acetylcholine receptors. These receptors respond to the chemical messenger acetylcholine and help control nerve signals, skeletal-muscle movement, attention, and some automatic body functions.

Nicotinic Acetylcholine Receptor

A pentameric ligand-gated cation channel activated by acetylcholine and, at many receptor subtypes, nicotine. Muscle-type receptors mediate transmission at the skeletal neuromuscular junction; neuronal subtypes occur in autonomic ganglia and the central nervous system and influence diverse neural functions.

Alternate Names:
nAChR

Nicotinic Acid

Alternate name; see *Niacin*.

NICU Staff

NICU staff are the healthcare professionals who monitor and treat newborns in a neonatal intensive care unit and support their families.

Nidation

Implantation of a fertilized egg into the lining of the uterus early in pregnancy. The term is largely synonymous with implantation.

Nidus

A starting point or central focus from which a process develops. In medicine, it may mean the core of a kidney stone, the focus of an infection, or the central part of an abnormal blood-vessel network.

Niemann-Pick Disease

A group of rare inherited lysosomal storage disorders in which lipids accumulate in cells. The group includes acid sphingomyelinase deficiency, formerly called Niemann-Pick disease types A and B, and Niemann-Pick disease type C, caused by impaired intracellular cholesterol trafficking. Features vary by type and may include enlargement of the liver or spleen, lung disease, difficulty coordinating movement, and progressive neurologic impairment.

Nifedipine

A medicine that relaxes blood vessels to lower blood pressure and relieve some types of chest pain. It may cause flushing, headache, dizziness, ankle swelling, or a fast heartbeat; the dose depends on the condition and formulation.

Night Blindness

Difficulty seeing in dim light or darkness. Causes include vitamin A deficiency, inherited retinal disorders, cataracts, glaucoma, and some medicines.

Night-Blindness

Alternate spelling; see *Night Blindness*.

Night Eating

A pattern of eating after dinner or waking to eat during the night, sometimes with reduced morning appetite; persistent distress or impairment may indicate night eating syndrome or another eating disorder.

Night Eating Syndrome

A recurring pattern of eating much of the day's food in the evening or after waking at night, often with little morning appetite and sleep problems. When it causes significant distress or affects daily life, it may be diagnosed as an other specified feeding or eating disorder after other causes are considered.

Night Leg Cramps

Sudden, painful involuntary contractions of leg muscles occurring during sleep or rest, often affecting the calf or foot.

Nightmare Disorder

Repeated frightening dreams that cause distress, wake a person, or interfere with sleep and daytime activities. It may be linked with stress, trauma, medicines, mental health conditions, or other sleep disorders.

Nightmares

Vivid frightening dreams that cause distress or wake a person, sometimes linked to stress, illness, or medicines.

Night Sweats

Episodes of excessive sweating during sleep that soak clothing or bedding. They may occur with infection, hormonal changes, cancer, medication effects, or other systemic illness. The term describes a symptom and does not identify its cause.

Alternate Names:
Sleep Hyperhidrosis; Nocturnal Diaphoresis

Night-Sweats

Alternate spelling; see *Night Sweats*.

Night Sweats in Men

Alternate name; see *Night Sweats*.

Night Terrors

Sudden episodes of fear, screaming, or confusion during deep non-REM sleep. A person may be difficult to wake and usually remembers little afterward. They occur most often in children.

Night Terrors In Children

Alternate name; see *Night Terrors*.

NIH Stroke Scale

The National Institutes of Health Stroke Scale is a standardized, validated clinical assessment tool used to quantify the severity of acute ischemic stroke.

Nijmegen Breakage Syndrome

A rare autosomal-recessive DNA-repair disorder caused by pathogenic variants in *NBN*. It can cause progressive microcephaly, growth and developmental differences, combined immunodeficiency, chromosomal instability, and increased cancer risk, particularly lymphoma. The older label "ataxia-telangiectasia variant 1" is no longer preferred because this is a distinct disorder.

Alternate Names:
NBS

Nikethamide

An old medicine once used to stimulate breathing. It is no longer a routine treatment because its benefit is limited and excessive doses can cause agitation, shaking, seizures, or other dangerous effects.

Nikolsky Sign

Peeling or separation of the top skin layer when nearby skin is gently rubbed. It can occur in serious blistering disorders, but the sign is not specific and must be interpreted with the rash and other findings.

Nikolsky's Sign

Shearing or peeling of the superficial epidermis when apparently normal skin beside a blister is rubbed; it may occur in pemphigus and other blistering disorders.

Nipah Virus

A zoonotic RNA virus in the genus *Henipavirus*, naturally carried by fruit bats of the family Pteropodidae. It can infect people and other mammals and spread from animals, through contaminated food, or by close contact between people. In humans it causes Nipah virus infection; see *Nipah Virus Infection*.

Nipah Virus Infection

A zoonotic disease caused by Nipah virus, transmitted to people from infected bats or other animals, contaminated food, or close contact with an infected person. Infection may be asymptomatic or cause fever, headache, vomiting, and respiratory illness; severe disease can progress to encephalitis, confusion, seizures, coma, or death.

Nipple

The projection at the centre of the breast through which milk is released from the mammary ducts; it contains smooth muscle and sensory nerve endings.

Nipple Adenoma

A rare benign growth of the small milk ducts within the nipple. It may cause a small lump, erosion, crusting, redness, or discharge and can resemble Paget disease of the breast.

Alternate Names:
Erosive Adenomatosis Of The Nipple; Erosive Adenomatosis; Erosive Papillomatosis Of The Nipple; Papillary Adenoma Of The Nipple

Nipple-Areola Complex

The nipple together with the darker skin around it, called the areola. It contains ducts, smooth muscle, glands, and sensory nerves.

Nipple Discharge

Fluid coming from one or both nipples, either on its own or when touched or squeezed. It may be related to pregnancy, breastfeeding, hormones, medicines, infection, or a breast-duct problem. Spontaneous discharge from one breast or duct, especially if bloody or clear, can be associated with an underlying lesion.

Nipple Eczema

An itchy, sore, red, or scaly rash affecting the nipple and areola. It is a type of skin inflammation and may be related to eczema or contact irritation. Persistent changes affecting only one nipple can have other causes, including Paget disease of the breast.

Nipple Inversion Or Retraction

Inward turning or pulling-in of the nipple. It may be longstanding and benign, but new one-sided inversion or retraction can occur with duct disease or breast cancer.

Nipple Retraction

Alternate name; see *Nipple Inversion Or Retraction*.

Niridazole

An older medicine once used against schistosomiasis, a parasitic infection. Its use is now limited because of serious possible side effects, including seizures, liver injury, and damage to blood-cell production.

Nissen Fundoplication

An antireflux operation in which the upper stomach is wrapped completely around the lower esophagus to reinforce the gastroesophageal junction. It may be combined with repair of a hiatal hernia and is used in selected cases of gastroesophageal reflux disease. The complete wrap distinguishes it from partial fundoplication procedures.

Alternate Names:
360-Degree Complete Fundoplication; Total Antireflux Fundoplication

Nit

The egg of a louse, usually attached firmly to a hair shaft or clothing fiber. Nits may be confused with dandruff, but they do not brush away easily. Finding live lice confirms an active infestation; treatment and fine combing remove lice and eggs.

Nitabuch Layer

A fibrinoid layer at the maternal-fetal interface between the decidua basalis and anchoring placental trophoblast. It is associated with limitation of trophoblast invasion and may be attenuated or absent at sites of placenta accreta spectrum; abnormal placental attachment also reflects defects in the decidua and uterine wall.

Alternate Names:
Stria of Nitabuch; Decidual Fibrinoid Boundary

Nitrates

Medicines that widen blood vessels by releasing nitric oxide. They can relieve angina and lower the heart's workload but may cause headache, flushing, dizziness, or dangerously low blood pressure with certain medicines.

Nitrate Tolerance

Reduced vascular or antianginal response to nitrate medicines after sustained exposure. It can limit the effect of continuously administered nitrates and is associated with changes in nitrate bioactivation and vascular signaling.

Nitrazepam

A benzodiazepine medicine that slows brain activity and can cause sleepiness, calmness, and seizure prevention. It can cause dependence, falls, memory problems, and dangerously slow breathing, especially with alcohol or opioids.

Nitric Acid

A strong corrosive chemical that can burn skin, eyes, mouth, throat, and digestive organs. Breathing its fumes can injure the lungs, and swallowed or inhaled exposure can cause severe poisoning.

Nitric Acid Poisoning

Exposure to nitric acid can severely burn the skin, eyes, mouth, throat, and stomach and may damage the lungs if fumes are inhaled.

Nitric Oxide

A short-lived signaling molecule made by many cells. It relaxes blood-vessel muscle, helping regulate blood flow and pressure, and also participates in nerve signaling and immune defense. Too much or too little production may contribute to disease.

Nitric Oxide Synthase

An enzyme family that catalyzes the synthesis of the gaseous signaling molecule nitric oxide (NO) and L-citrulline from L-arginine, oxygen, and NADPH, comprising constitutive calcium-dependent isoforms (endothelial eNOS, neuronal nNOS) and a calcium-independent inducible isoform (iNOS).

Alternate Names:
NOS

Nitrofurantoin

An antibacterial medicine used mainly for bladder infections caused by susceptible bacteria. It concentrates in urine but is not suitable for many kidney infections; nausea, lung reactions, liver injury, or nerve problems are uncommon but important risks.

Nitrogen

An essential element in amino acids, proteins, nucleic acids, and other biological molecules; atmospheric nitrogen is largely inert to humans.

Nitrogen Balance

The difference between dietary nitrogen intake, estimated mainly from protein intake, and nitrogen loss, primarily in urine. Positive balance supports growth or tissue repair; negative balance occurs with inadequate intake, inflammation, trauma, or catabolic disease.

Nitrogenous Base

A nitrogen-containing component of nucleic acids; adenine, guanine, cytosine, thymine, and uracil pair in DNA or RNA to encode genetic information.

Nitroglycerin

An organic nitrate that releases nitric oxide and relaxes vascular smooth muscle. Its principal cardiovascular use is relief or prevention of angina through venodilation, reduced cardiac preload, and lower myocardial oxygen demand; it can also dilate coronary arteries.

Nitroglycerin for Chest Pain

A symptom-based term for nitroglycerin used to relieve angina caused by transient myocardial ischemia. Nitroglycerin is an organic nitrate that relaxes vascular smooth muscle and reduces cardiac preload; the term refers to its antianginal use, not to chest pain from other causes.

Nitroglycerin Overdose

Too much nitroglycerin can cause severe headache, flushing, dizziness, fainting, low blood pressure, fast heartbeat, or breathing difficulty.

Nitromors

A trade name for paint or varnish stripper formulations; exposure can cause chemical burns or toxic inhalation.

Nitrosoureas

A group of chemotherapy medicines that can cross the blood-brain barrier and damage DNA; examples include carmustine and lomustine.

Nitrous Oxide

An inhaled anesthetic and analgesic gas, administered with oxygen for procedural or labor analgesia and as an adjunct to general anesthesia. It acts rapidly but has low anesthetic potency, so it is not adequate alone for most general anesthesia. It can expand gas-filled spaces and inactivate vitamin B12, particularly with prolonged or repeated exposure or deficiency.

Nitrous Oxide For Labor

A mixture of nitrous oxide and oxygen inhaled through a mask or mouthpiece to help relieve pain during labor. The person in labor controls when to inhale it; availability and use depend on local practice.

Nizatidine

A histamine H2-receptor blocker that reduces stomach-acid production and is used for peptic ulcers and gastroesophageal reflux. It is cleared mainly by the kidneys, and drug interactions can occur.

NMR

NMR, or nuclear magnetic resonance, measures how atomic nuclei respond to a magnetic field and is used in chemical analysis and imaging.

Nocardia Asteroides Infection

A historical label for nocardiosis when the organism was identified as *Nocardia asteroides* or assigned to the former *N. asteroides* group. That group included several species now classified separately, so the label may not identify the infecting species precisely. Nocardiosis can affect the lungs, skin, or brain, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Nocardia Infection

An infection caused by Nocardia bacteria, usually affecting the lungs, skin, or brain, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Nocardiosis

An infection caused by Nocardia bacteria found in soil and water. It most often affects the lungs, skin, or brain, especially in people with weakened immunity, and may cause cough, fever, skin sores, confusion, or seizures.

Nocebo

A harmful or unpleasant symptom or treatment effect caused or amplified by negative expectations rather than by the treatment's specific pharmacologic action.

Nociception

The nervous system's detection and processing of potentially harmful heat, pressure, or chemicals. It can lead to pain, but pain also depends on how the brain interprets these signals.

Nociceptor

A specialized sensory nerve ending that detects potentially harmful or tissue-damaging stimuli—such as extreme heat or cold, intense pressure, or irritant chemicals. When activated, nociceptors send electrical warning signals through the spinal cord to the brain, where the sensation is interpreted as pain, triggering protective reflexes to prevent or minimize physical injury.

Nociceptors

Plural form; see *Nociceptor*.

Nocturia

Waking during the night one or more times to urinate and then returning to sleep. It may result from evening fluids, medicines, bladder or prostate problems, diabetes, heart disease, or sleep disorders.

Nocturnal

Occurring at night or during sleep. Examples include bedwetting, nighttime cough, breathing pauses during sleep, nighttime low oxygen, or breathlessness that wakes a person. Persistent or severe symptoms can have significant underlying causes.

Nocturnal Emission

Involuntary ejaculation during sleep, sometimes called a wet dream. It is a common and normal event during male puberty and adolescence.

Alternate Names:
Wet Dream

Nocturnal Enuresis

Repeated involuntary urination during sleep in a child aged five years or older, the usual age threshold for the diagnosis. It may be primary, when nighttime dryness has never been established, or secondary, when bedwetting returns after a sustained dry period. Daytime urinary symptoms may indicate a broader bladder disorder.

Alternate Names:
Sleep Enuresis

Nocturnal Hypoventilation

A reduction in minute ventilation occurring specifically during sleep, resulting in nighttime hypercapnia and hypoxemia, commonly encountered in neuromuscular diseases (such as ALS or muscular dystrophies), severe kyphoscoliosis, and obesity hypoventilation syndrome.

Nocturnal Incontinence

Alternate name; see *Incontinence*.

Nocturnal Lagophthalmos

Incomplete closure of the eyelids during sleep, which

may cause dryness, irritation, and exposure injury to the cornea.

Nocturnal Polyuria

Production of an unusually large share of the day's urine during nighttime sleep. It can contribute to repeated nighttime urination and may be related to fluid shifts, sleep disorders, medicines, or other medical conditions.

Nocturnal Pruritus

Itching that occurs or worsens at night and may interrupt sleep. It is a symptom pattern rather than a distinct disease and may accompany skin disorders or systemic causes of pruritus.

Alternate Names:
Nighttime Itching

Nodal Rhythm

A heartbeat rhythm that starts near the atrioventricular node instead of the heart's usual pacemaker. It may occur when the normal pacemaker is slow or blocked and can cause a slow pulse, dizziness, or no symptoms.

Node

A localized swelling, structure, or point of connection; examples include lymph nodes and electrical conduction nodes.

Node of Ranvier

Periodic, unmyelinated gaps or interruptions occurring at regular intervals along the length of a myelinated nerve axon where high concentrations of voltage-gated sodium channels enable rapid saltatory nerve impulse conduction.

Alternate Names:
Ranvier Node; Myelin Sheath Gap

Nodular

Made up of or containing one or more rounded lumps called nodules. The word may describe a skin lesion, thyroid swelling, lung finding, or other tissue. Its importance depends on the nodule's size, appearance, location, growth, and associated symptoms.

Nodular Fasciitis

A rapidly growing benign self-limited fibroblastic and myofibroblastic proliferation, usually presenting as a painful or tender superficial mass. It can mimic sarcoma clinically and microscopically.

Nodular Localized Cutaneous Amyloidosis

A localized cutaneous amyloidosis presenting as one or more firm, waxy, skin-colored or yellow-brown nodules. It is usually confined to the skin, but examination may be needed to distinguish it from systemic amyloidosis or other nodular disorders.

Nodular Lymphoid Hyperplasia

Enlargement of small areas of immune tissue, most often in the small intestine. It is usually harmless but may be associated with reduced antibody production or intestinal infection; its significance depends on symptoms and the test findings.

Nodular Melanoma

A type of skin cancer that grows downward early and often appears as a rapidly enlarging firm bump. It may be black, brown, pink, or skin-colored; rapid growth or bleeding can occur.

Nodular Vasculitis

Alternate name; see *Erythema Induratum*.

Nodule

A small, rounded area of abnormal tissue that may be solid or fluid-filled and may occur in the skin, lung, thyroid, or another organ. Its significance depends on location, size, appearance, growth, and symptoms; some are harmless, while others reflect neoplastic or inflammatory disease.

Noise-Induced Hearing Loss

Hearing loss caused by very loud sound, either from one sudden blast or repeated exposure over time. It is often permanent and may occur with ringing in the ears or trouble understanding speech, especially

in noisy places.

Noise-Related Hearing Loss

Alternate name; see *Hearing Loss*.

Noma

A rapidly progressive gangrenous disease of the mouth and face, usually affecting severely malnourished or immunocompromised children. It often begins as necrotizing gingivitis and can destroy oral and facial soft tissue and bone. The condition is associated with extreme poverty, malnutrition, impaired immunity, and polymicrobial infection.

Nomenclature

Nomenclature is the organized system used to name and classify diseases, organisms, chemicals, anatomy, medicines, or other entities.

Nomogram

A graphical tool that estimates a quantity or risk from related measurements. The Rumack–Matthew nomogram is used in selected cases of acute acetaminophen ingestion.

Nonaccidental Injury

An injury caused deliberately or by neglect rather than by an accident. In children, suspicious patterns may include injuries inconsistent with the history, injuries at different stages of healing, or injuries in protected areas.

Non-Accidental Trauma

An injury caused deliberately or through abuse rather than by an accident. It is considered when the explanation does not fit the injuries, when injuries are repeated or occur at different healing stages, or when a child cannot explain what happened; safeguarding assessment may be involved.

Non-Adherence

The extent to which a person's medication use or other health behavior differs from a mutually agreed plan. It may be intentional or unintentional and can reflect access barriers, adverse effects, beliefs, communication problems, or practical difficulties; the term does not itself identify the reason.

Non-Alcoholic Steatohepatitis

An older name for metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH), a form of steatotic liver disease with liver-cell injury and inflammation. It can cause scarring and, in some people, cirrhosis or liver cancer.

Alternate Names:
NASH; Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatohepatitis (MASH)

Nonalcoholic Steatohepatitis Pathology

Liver-tissue findings associated with metabolic dysfunction-associated steatohepatitis (MASH), including fat in liver cells, cell injury, and inflammation, with or without scarring. NASH is an older name for MASH.

Non-Allergic Rhinitis

Alternate spelling; see *Nonallergic Rhinitis*.

Nonallergic Rhinitis

Nasal congestion, sneezing, or runny nose caused by irritants or other triggers rather than an allergic immune response. Triggers may include changes in temperature or humidity, smoke, odors, medicines, or hormonal changes.

Alternate Names:
NAR

Nonallergic Rhinopathy

Alternate name; see *Nonallergic Rhinitis*.

Non-Articular Rheumatism

An older term for painful disorders of muscles, tendons, bursae, or other tissues outside the joints.

Nonarticular Rheumatism/Regional Pain Syndrome

A broad clinical category of pain arising outside the joints, including disorders of muscles, tendons, bursae, fascia, nerves, or other regional soft tissues. The cause may be overuse, injury, inflammation,

nerve dysfunction, or altered pain processing.

Non-Asthmatic Eosinophilic Bronchitis

A cause of long-lasting cough in which certain white blood cells inflame the airways without the variable narrowing seen in asthma. Breathing tests may be normal, but an inhaled corticosteroid can reduce the cough when this diagnosis is confirmed.

Nonbacterial Prostatitis

Chronic pelvic pain syndrome (CP/CPPS) characterized by persistent pelvic, perineal, or genital pain and urinary symptoms for at least 3 months without evidence of active urinary tract bacterial infection on standard cultures.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Pelvic Pain Syndrome in Men; Abacterial Prostatitis; Category III Prostatitis

Nonbacterial Thrombotic Endocarditis

Small, sterile blood clots that form on heart valves without infection. It is often linked to cancer, lupus, or another condition that makes blood clot easily. The clots can break off and cause stroke or blockage elsewhere, so treatment focuses on the cause and preventing further clots.

Alternate Names:
NBTE; Marantic Endocarditis

Noncandidal Fungal Infections of the Mouth

Fungal infections of the oral cavity caused by organisms other than Candida, including selected dermatophytes, molds, and endemic fungi. They may produce plaques, ulcers, swelling, or deep tissue disease and often require culture, biopsy, or systemic treatment.

Non-Celiac Gluten Intolerance

Alternate name; see *Non-Celiac Gluten Sensitivity*.

Non-Celiac Gluten Sensitivity

Symptoms attributed to gluten or wheat that improve after removal, despite testing not showing celiac disease or wheat allergy. Other foods and conditions can cause similar symptoms, complicating diagnosis.

Non-Coding RNA (ncRNA)

An RNA molecule that is not translated into a protein. Non-coding RNAs can regulate gene activity, RNA processing, protein production, and chromosome function; abnormal regulation is involved in some cancers and other diseases.

Non-Communicable Disease

A health condition that does not spread from person to person, such as heart disease, cancer, chronic lung disease, or diabetes. Many result from a mix of inherited, environmental, and lifestyle factors.

Alternate Names:
NCD; Non-Communicable Diseases; Noncommunicable Disease

Non Communicating Hydrocephalus

A buildup of cerebrospinal fluid in the brain because a blockage prevents it from moving between the brain's fluid-filled spaces and reaching the area where it is absorbed. It can increase pressure on the brain and cause headache, vomiting, sleepiness, vision problems, or difficulty walking.

Noncompetitive Antagonist

A medicine that reduces another medicine or natural chemical's effect by attaching to its receptor or signaling pathway in a way that extra amounts of the activating substance cannot fully overcome.

Noncompetitive Inhibition

A form of enzyme inhibition in which a substance binds away from the enzyme's working site and reduces its activity. Because it does not compete directly with the usual substrate, adding more substrate does not fully overcome the inhibition.

Non-Compliant Angioplasty Balloon

A small balloon on a catheter that keeps its shape when inflated at high pressure to widen a narrowed blood vessel. It is used during selected vascular procedures and can rarely cause bleeding, vessel injury, or blockage.

Alternate Names:
High-Pressure Angioplasty Balloon; Non-Compliant Balloon

Non-Contact Tonometry

A quick estimate of pressure inside the eye using a brief puff of air against the clear front surface of the eye. It does not touch the eye and can screen for glaucoma, but unusual results may need confirmation.

Non-Convulsive Status Epilepticus

Alternate spelling; see *Nonconvulsive Status Epilepticus*.

Nonconvulsive Status Epilepticus

Ongoing seizure activity without prominent convulsive movements. It may present as prolonged confusion, reduced awareness, behavioral change, or subtle movements. Electroencephalography is central to diagnosis, with findings interpreted alongside the person's clinical state and other evidence.

Alternate Names:
NCSE

Nondisjunction

Failure of chromosome copies to separate properly when a cell divides. This can produce cells with too many or too few chromosomes and may cause conditions such as Down syndrome, Turner syndrome, or some miscarriages.

Non-Fatal Drowning

Respiratory impairment from submersion or immersion in liquid when the person survives. Outcomes range from no lasting effects to ongoing health problems.

Non-Functioning Pituitary Adenoma

A usually noncancerous pituitary tumor that does not release enough active hormones to cause a hormone syndrome. As it enlarges, it may cause headache, reduced vision, or loss of normal pituitary function.

Nongenital Warts

Common benign skin growths caused by cutaneous human papillomaviruses, usually appearing as rough papules on the hands, fingers, elbows, or knees; plantar warts affect the soles. They spread by direct contact or self-inoculation, may persist for months or years, and are distinct from anogenital warts.

Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma

A broad group of blood cancers that originate in lymphocytes, a type of white blood cell that forms part of the immune system. The cancerous cells multiply abnormally in lymph nodes and lymphatic tissue, leading to painless swelling of lymph nodes in the neck, armpits, or groin, as well as systemic symptoms such as persistent fever, drenching night sweats, fatigue, and unexplained weight loss. Types range from slow-growing (indolent) to fast-growing (aggressive) forms.

Alternate Names:
NHL; Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma; Non-Hodgkins Lymphoma

Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma In Children

A group of childhood cancers arising from immune cells called lymphocytes. Some grow quickly and can cause swollen nodes, fever, abdominal symptoms, or breathing problems; the exact type and spread determine treatment.

Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma

Alternate spelling; see *Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma*.

Non-Hodgkins Lymphomas

Alternate spelling and plural form; see *Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma*.

Non-Infectious Cystitis

Alternate spelling; see *Noninfectious Cystitis*.

Noninfectious Cystitis

Bladder inflammation not caused by an active infection. Causes include radiation, some medicines, chemicals, and interstitial cystitis. It can cause pain, urgency, and frequent urination.

Alternate Names:
Abacterial Cystitis; Sterile Cystitis

Noninfectious Uveitis

Inflammation inside the eye not caused by an active infection, often related to autoimmune or inflammatory disease. It can threaten vision; treatment varies with the site and underlying cause.

Noninvasive

Describes a test, treatment, or device that does not enter the body or breach the skin, such as ultrasound or an external electrocardiogram. In oncology, "noninvasive" describes a neoplasm confined to its epithelial layer without invasion through the basement membrane into underlying tissue; the precise meaning depends on the tumor type.

Non-Invasive Positive Pressure Ventilation

The delivery of mechanical ventilatory support without an invasive endotracheal tube or tracheostomy, utilizing a tight-fitting facial or nasal mask to provide continuous positive airway pressure (CPAP) or bilevel positive airway pressure (BiPAP) in acute hypercapnic respiratory failure or cardiogenic pulmonary edema.

Alternate Names:
NIPPV; NPPV

Non-Invasive Prenatal Testing

Alternate name; see *Cell-Free Fetal DNA Screening*.

Non-Invasive Procedure

An examination or treatment that does not cut or pierce the skin or place an instrument inside the body. Examples include blood-pressure measurement, electrocardiography, ultrasound, magnetic resonance imaging, and external physical therapy. The term describes how a procedure is performed, not its accuracy, effectiveness, or overall risk.

Alternate Names:
Noninvasive Procedure; Non-Invasive Medical Procedure; Non-Invasive Technique

Non-Invasive Ventilation

Breathing support delivered through a face or nose mask instead of a tube placed in the windpipe. Continuous or two-level air pressure can improve breathing in selected people with respiratory failure, sleep apnea, or fluid in the lungs.

Nonischemic Priapism

Alternate name; see *Priapism*.

Nonketotic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome

A life-threatening diabetic emergency in which very high blood sugar causes profound dehydration and concentrated blood, usually without major ketone buildup. It can cause extreme thirst, weakness, confusion, seizures, coma, and organ failure.

Non-Ketotic Hyperosmolar State

Alternate name; see *Nonketotic Hyperglycemic Hyperosmolar Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State; HHS

Nonmelanoma Skin Cancer

A group of skin cancers that arise from the cells of the epidermis, excluding melanoma. The two most common types are basal cell carcinoma (BCC) and squamous cell carcinoma (SCC), which together account for the vast majority of all skin cancers diagnosed globally.

Non-Muscle-Invasive Bladder Cancer

Bladder cancer limited to the inner lining or connective tissue beneath it, without invasion of the bladder muscle. It can recur and may progress to muscle-invasive disease.

Non-Obstructive Azoospermia

Complete absence of sperm in semen because the testicles make too few or no sperm, rather than because a tube is blocked. Causes include genetic conditions, undescended testes, infections, cancer treatment, or an unknown problem. Testing may include hormone tests and genetic studies; some

people can use surgically retrieved sperm for assisted reproduction.

Non-Ossifying Fibroma

A common, noncancerous bone lesion, usually found by chance in the leg bones of children or teenagers. It often causes no symptoms and may shrink as the skeleton matures. A large lesion can weaken the bone and rarely lead to a fracture.

Alternate Names:
NOA; Secretory Azoospermia; Testicular Failure Azoospermia

Nonpathogenic

Nonpathogenic means not ordinarily capable of causing disease in a given host or setting; an organism can still cause opportunistic infection when immunity or barriers are impaired.

Non-Pitting Edema

Swelling of subcutaneous tissue that does not leave a persistent indentation when firm digital pressure is applied, usually due to local accumulation of protein-rich fluid, mucopolysaccharides, or chronic cellular infiltration. Common causes include lymphedema, pretibial myxedema in Graves disease, and severe lipedema.

Non-Polio Enterovirus Infection

Alternate name; see *Enterovirus*.

Non-Proliferative Diabetic Retinopathy

An early form of diabetes-related damage to the retina, the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye. Small blood vessels may leak or swell, causing blurred vision, but abnormal new vessels have not formed.

Nonproliferative Retinopathy

Retinal disease in which small blood vessels leak or become damaged without abnormal new vessels growing. Diabetes is a common cause; progression can impair vision, especially when the macula is affected.

Alternate Names:
NPDR

Non-Radiographic Axial Spondyloarthritis

Inflammatory arthritis affecting the spine or joints between the spine and pelvis without definite changes on a plain X-ray. It may cause persistent back pain and morning stiffness, and may occur with eye inflammation, psoriasis, or inflammatory bowel disease.

Non-Rapid Eye Movement Sleep

Sleep that includes lighter and deeper stages without rapid eye movements. Deep stages support physical restoration, while lighter stages help the body transition into and out of sleep.

Non-Rebreather Mask

An oxygen-delivery mask with a reservoir bag and one-way valves intended to limit rebreathing of exhaled gas and entry of room air. The delivered oxygen concentration depends on oxygen flow, mask fit, valve design, and the person's breathing pattern; it is not a fixed concentration device.

Alternate Names:
NRB Mask

Non-REM Sleep

Sleep stages without rapid eye movements, ranging from light sleep to deep slow-wave sleep. These stages support physical restoration, memory processing, and the normal transition between waking and sleep.

Alternate Names:
NREM sleep

Non-Responder

A person or disease that shows little or no expected response to a treatment, vaccine, or test stimulus.

Non-Scarring Epidermolysis Bullosa

An epidermolysis bullosa subtype in which genetic fragility causes blisters or erosions without primary scarring; severity and complications depend on the subtype.

Nonselective Beta-Blockers

Medicines that block two main types of adrenaline receptor. They slow the heart and lower blood pressure but can also narrow the airways, which can worsen asthma or some other lung diseases.

Non-Seminomatous Germ Cell Tumor

Alternate spelling; see *Nonseminomatous Germ Cell Tumor*.

Nonseminomatous Germ Cell Tumor

A group of cancers that begin in germ cells, the cells that develop into eggs or sperm. They most often start in a testicle but can occur elsewhere. Types include embryonal carcinoma, yolk sac tumor, choriocarcinoma, and teratoma.

Alternate Names:
NSGCT; Nonseminoma

Nonseminomatous Testicular Tumors

Testicular germ-cell tumors containing or resembling embryonal carcinoma, yolk-sac tumor, choriocarcinoma, teratoma, or mixed components. They may produce elevated AFP or hCG and require staging with tumor markers, imaging, and examination of the contralateral testis.

Nonsense Variant

A change in DNA that tells a cell to stop making a protein too early. The resulting shortened or missing protein may cause disease, but the effect depends on the gene, the location of the change, and how much normal protein remains.

Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer

A group of lung cancers that includes adenocarcinoma, squamous-cell cancer, and large-cell cancer. It is more common than small-cell lung cancer; treatment depends on the cancer type, how far it has spread, and gene changes.

Alternate Names:
NSCLC

Non-Small Cell Lung Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer*.

Nonspecific Interstitial Pneumonia

An interstitial lung disease pattern with relatively uniform inflammation and/or fibrosis across affected areas, rather than the temporally varied pattern of usual interstitial pneumonia. It may be idiopathic or associated with connective-tissue disease, medicines, or other exposures and can cause dry cough and breathlessness.

Nonspecific Interstitial Pneumonitis

Alternate name; see *Nonspecific Interstitial Pneumonia*.

Non-Specific Urethritis

Inflammation of the urethra that is not caused by *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*; it may be caused by other infectious agents, including *Chlamydia trachomatis*, or sometimes have no identified cause. Symptoms can include painful urination or urethral discharge.

Nongonococcal Urethritis

Alternate name; see *Non-Specific Urethritis*.

Non-ST Elevation Myocardial Infarction

Alternate spelling; see *Non-ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction*.

Non-ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction

A heart attack in which blood tests show heart-muscle injury but the electrocardiogram does not show persistent ST-segment elevation. It is usually caused by reduced or blocked blood flow to the heart and can cause permanent cardiac injury or death.

Alternate Names:
NSTEMI; Non-ST-Segment Elevation Infarct

Nonsteroidal Anti-inflammatory Drug (NSAID) Toxicity

Harmful effects from excessive exposure to a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug. Symptoms may include nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, gastrointestinal bleeding, ringing in the ears, or drowsiness; severe poisoning can cause acute kidney injury, metabolic acidosis, seizures, or coma.

Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs

A group of medicines that reduce pain, fever, and inflammation by lowering the body's production of prostaglandins. They can cause stomach bleeding, kidney injury, fluid retention, heart problems, or allergic reactions, especially at high doses or with long use.

Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drugs And Ulcers

Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs can reduce stomach-protective prostaglandins and cause gastritis, ulcers, and gastrointestinal bleeding. Risk rises with age, prior ulcer, anticoagulants, steroids, kidney disease, and high doses; safer alternatives or acid protection may be needed.

Alternate Names:
NSAID-Induced Peptic Ulcer; NSAID Gastropathy

Non-Stress Test

A test during pregnancy that monitors the baby's heart rate while the baby moves. A healthy response usually includes temporary heart-rate increases; an abnormal result may reflect sleep, medicines, or a problem requiring further assessment.

Non-ST-Segment Elevation Myocardial Infarction

Alternate name; see *Non-ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction*.

Nonsyndromic

Nonsyndromic means occurring without the additional characteristic features of a recognized syndrome; it may still be genetic, congenital, or clinically significant.

Nonthrombocytopenic Idiopathic Purpura

Purpura or easy bruising with a normal platelet count and no identified cause; the evaluation considers vessel fragility, medicines, coagulation disorders, nutritional deficiency, and systemic disease.

Nontraditional Medicine

Treatments outside conventional evidence-based medical practice, including some complementary, alternative, or traditional systems. Safety and effectiveness vary, and interactions or delayed diagnosis are possible.

Nontropical Sprue

Alternate name; see *Celiac Disease*.

Nontuberculous Mycobacteria

Mycobacteria other than the tuberculosis complex and M. leprae. They are found in soil and water and can cause lung, skin, lymph-node, or disseminated infections, especially in people with underlying illness.

Nontuberculous Mycobacterial Infection

Infection caused by Mycobacterium species other than M. tuberculosis, often affecting the lungs but sometimes the lymph nodes, skin, or other organs. Disease is more likely in people with structural lung disease or impaired immunity.

Nontuberculous Mycobacterial Lung Disease

Lung disease caused by mycobacteria in the environment, not by the bacteria that cause tuberculosis. It may cause cough, breathlessness, tiredness, or weight loss, but some people carry these bacteria without becoming ill. Symptoms, scans, and repeated lab tests help distinguish disease from bacteria that are present without causing illness.

Nontuberculous Mycobacterial (NTM) Diseases

Infections caused by environmental mycobacteria other than the tuberculosis complex and *M. leprae*. They may affect the lungs, skin, lymph nodes, or other organs, especially in people with underlying lung disease or weakened immunity. Lung disease may cause cough, fatigue, weight loss, breathlessness, or coughing blood; diagnosis and treatment depend on symptoms, imaging, and test results.

Nonulcer Dyspepsia

Alternate name; see *Functional Dyspepsia*.

Nonulcer Stomach Pain

Alternate name; see *Functional Dyspepsia*.

Nonunion And Malunion

Nonunion means a broken bone fails to heal after an expected period, leaving pain or instability. Malunion means it heals in a poor position, causing deformity, altered movement, or strain on nearby joints. Both may require further treatment.

Nonunion Fracture

A broken bone that has failed to heal after the expected period and shows no further progress toward joining. It may cause ongoing pain, movement at the fracture, weakness, or deformity and may require surgery or other treatment.

Nonverbal Learning Disorder

A neurodevelopmental profile characterized by well-developed verbal abilities contrasted with significant deficits in visual-spatial perception, motor coordination, and nonverbal social comprehension.

Noonan Syndrome

An inherited condition that may cause distinctive facial features, short stature, heart defects, delayed development, easy bruising, or swelling from lymph problems. Its features vary; care often includes monitoring of heart, growth, hearing, and development.

Noonan Syndrome With Multiple Lentigines

A genetic disorder, formerly called LEOPARD syndrome, characterized by multiple lentigines and variable features such as distinctive facial appearance, short stature, heart disease, hearing loss, or genital abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
LEOPARD Syndrome (historical term)

Noradrenaline

A chemical messenger acting as both a hormone and neurotransmitter. It helps regulate alertness, attention, stress responses, heart activity, and blood-vessel tightening, which can raise blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Norepinephrine

No-Reflow Phenomenon

Failure of blood to reach small vessels and damaged tissue even after a larger blocked artery has been reopened. It can occur after a heart attack or stroke and may limit recovery despite successful treatment of the main blockage.

Norepinephrine

A hormone and nerve messenger involved in alertness, stress responses, heart function, and blood-vessel tightening. It can increase blood pressure and is also used in hospitals to support blood pressure during some forms of shock.

Alternate Names:
Noradrenaline

Norethisterone

A manufactured progesterone-like medicine used for contraception and selected menstrual problems or endometriosis. It can change bleeding patterns and may cause nausea, headache, mood changes, breast tenderness, or other hormone-related effects.

Norgestrel

A synthetic progestogen used in some hormonal contraceptives. It helps prevent pregnancy by suppressing ovulation and changing cervical mucus and the uterine lining.

Norketamine

Norketamine is an active metabolite of ketamine with NMDA-receptor antagonist activity; it contributes to ketamine's analgesic and psychoactive effects and may persist after the parent drug is cleared.

Normal

Within an expected range or consistent with usual anatomy, physiology, or function for a specified pop-

ulation.

Normal and Abnormal Puerperium

The puerperium is the weeks after birth while the uterus and other body systems recover. Normal findings include lochia, uterine involution, breast changes, fatigue, and emotional fluctuation; heavy bleeding, fever, severe pain, headache, breathlessness, or profound mood change may signal a complication.

Normal Flora

The bacteria, fungi, and other microorganisms that normally live on the skin and in the mouth, intestine, and urinary or genital tract without causing illness. They can help block harmful germs, support immunity, and contribute to digestion and vitamin production.

Normal Growth And Development

Normal growth and development describes expected physical growth, movement, language, learning, and social progress for a person's age and stage of life.

Normalization

A mathematical adjustment that makes measurements comparable by correcting for known differences in scale, background, equipment response, or other measurement conditions.

Normal Labor and Delivery

Spontaneous labor with progressive cervical dilation, descent and birth of the fetus, delivery of the placenta, and stable maternal and newborn adaptation. Labor can become prolonged or complicated by fetal distress, malposition, bleeding, or infection.

Normal Labour

Spontaneous labour at term with regular uterine contractions, progressive cervical dilatation, and delivery through the birth canal without major complication.

Normal Menstrual Cycle

The recurring hormonal and uterine changes that usually produce menstrual bleeding at a predictable interval; cycle length, flow, and symptoms vary, and persistent changes can reflect an underlying condition.

Normal Pressure Hydrocephalus

A type of hydrocephalus, usually in older adults, in which cerebrospinal fluid builds up and enlarges spaces inside the brain even though pressure readings may be normal. It often causes slow, unsteady walking, followed by changes in thinking and loss of bladder control. Some people improve after a shunt drains the fluid.

Normal-Pressure Hydrocephalus

Alternate spelling; see *Normal Pressure Hydrocephalus*.

Normal Range

A normal range is the interval of results commonly found in a reference population; a result outside it does not by itself prove disease.

Normal Saline

A sterile approximately 0.9% sodium-chloride solution used for fluid replacement, irrigation, and dilution of medicines.

Normal-Tension Glaucoma

A type of primary open-angle glaucoma in which glaucomatous optic-nerve damage occurs despite intraocular pressure (pressure inside the eye) readings within the statistically normal range. It may cause gradual loss of peripheral (side) vision without early symptoms.

Normoblast

A nucleated immature red-cell precursor in bone marrow that normally loses its nucleus before entering circulation.

Normocalcemic Hyperparathyroidism

Persistently elevated parathyroid hormone with normal blood calcium. This finding requires repeat testing and exclusion of secondary causes, such as

vitamin D deficiency, kidney disease, low calcium intake, poor absorption, or certain medicines, before normocalcemic primary hyperparathyroidism can be diagnosed.

Normocytic Anaemia

Alternate British spelling; see *Normocytic Anemia*.

Normocytic Anemia

Anemia in which red blood cells are about their usual size but the blood has too little hemoglobin. Causes include blood loss, breakdown of red cells, chronic illness, kidney disease, and bone-marrow problems. Other blood tests help identify the cause.

Alternate Names:
Normocytic Normochromic Anemia; Normal-MCV Anemia

Normotensive

Having blood pressure within the expected range for the person and measurement setting.

Norovirus

A highly contagious virus that causes acute gastroenteritis, or inflammation of the stomach and intestines. Symptoms usually begin 12–48 hours after exposure and include sudden nausea, vomiting, watery diarrhea, stomach cramps, and sometimes fever, headache, or body aches. It spreads mainly when tiny particles of stool or vomit enter the mouth, through infected people, contaminated food or water, surfaces, or particles released during vomiting. Most illness improves within 1–3 days, but severe fluid loss can cause dehydration, especially in infants, older adults, and people with other illnesses.

Noroviruses

A group of highly contagious viruses that cause acute gastroenteritis with vomiting, diarrhea, cramps, and dehydration; see *Norovirus*.

Norovirus Infection

Acute gastroenteritis caused by norovirus. Symptoms usually begin 12–48 hours after exposure and include nausea, vomiting, watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and sometimes fever, headache, or body aches. Infection spreads easily through infected people, contaminated food or water, surfaces, or particles released during vomiting. Most cases improve within 1–3 days, but fluid loss may cause dehydration, especially in infants, older adults, and people with other illnesses.

Norrbottnian Gaucher Disease

A rare northern-European genetic form of Gaucher disease, usually a non-neuronopathic type caused by inherited glucocerebrosidase deficiency; see *Gaucher Disease*.

Norrie Disease

A rare inherited eye disorder in which the retina develops abnormally, usually causing severe vision loss or blindness from birth or early infancy. Some people also develop hearing loss, developmental differences, or problems in the eye's blood vessels.

Nortriptyline

A medicine used to treat depression and sometimes long-lasting nerve pain. It changes the levels of certain chemical messengers in the nervous system and may cause dry mouth, constipation, sleepiness, dizziness, heart-rhythm problems, or overdose toxicity.

Norwegian Scabies

A severe form of scabies in which thick crusts contain very large numbers of mites. It is extremely contagious and occurs especially in people with weakened immunity or difficulty sensing or scratching the skin; management includes treatment and contact precautions.

Norwood Procedure

The first operation for many newborns with hypoplastic left heart syndrome and related heart defects. It rebuilds the main artery so the right ventricle can send blood to the body, creates a wide opening between the upper heart chambers, and provides controlled blood flow to the lungs through a shunt or tube. It is usually performed within the first days of life and is followed by further staged

operations.

Alternate Names:
Stage 1 Norwood Reconstruction; Norwood Operation

Nose

The external structure and internal passages used for breathing and smell. The nose warms, moistens, and filters air and contains bone, cartilage, skin, mucus, blood vessels, and smell-sensing tissue.

Nosebleed

Bleeding from the blood vessels lining the inside of the nasal passages (epistaxis). Most nosebleeds occur in the front part of the nose (anterior nosebleeds), where fragile blood vessels are easily irritated by dry air, nose picking, allergies, or minor trauma. Less commonly, bleeding originates from larger blood vessels deep in the back of the nose (posterior nosebleeds), which tends to be heavier, is more common in older adults or those with high blood pressure, and requires medical evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Epistaxis

Nosebleeds

Plural form; see *Nosebleed*.

Alternate Names:
Epistaxis

Nose Fracture

A break in one or more nasal bones caused by trauma, potentially causing pain, swelling, deformity, bleeding, or nasal obstruction.

Nosocomial

Acquired during healthcare, especially in a hospital, rather than being present or incubating when the person entered care. A nosocomial infection may be caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or other organisms and can involve drug-resistant organisms.

Nosocomial Infection

An infection acquired during healthcare that was not present or developing when the person entered care. It may occur in a hospital or another healthcare setting; timing and definition depend on the infection and surveillance rules.

Nosocomial Norovirus Infection

Norovirus gastroenteritis acquired in a healthcare setting. It causes sudden nausea, vomiting, watery diarrhea, and abdominal cramps and can spread rapidly, causing outbreaks in hospitals and long-term-care facilities.

Alternate Names:
Hospital-Acquired Norovirus

Nosocomial Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococci

Enterococcal bacteria that resist vancomycin and can spread in healthcare settings. They may cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or other infections, particularly in people who are seriously ill or have devices such as catheters; treatment requires susceptibility testing.

Nostril

One of the two openings at the front of the nose. Each nostril leads into the nasal passage, where hairs and mucus help trap particles before air reaches the deeper airways.

Alternate Names:
Nostrils; Nares

Notalgia Paresthetica

A localized neuropathic itch or burning sensation, usually between or just below the shoulder blades, caused by irritation or entrapment of thoracic sensory nerves. Scratching may produce a persistent darkened patch; treatment focuses on reducing itch and addressing contributing spine or nerve disease when present.

Notencephalocele

An older term for an occipital encephalocele, a congenital defect in the back of the skull through which brain tissue protrudes; the sac may also contain the membranes covering the brain.

Notifiable Disease

An infection or other condition that healthcare professionals or laboratories must report to public-health authorities under local law. Reporting helps detect outbreaks, arrange control measures, protect contacts, and plan services; the exact list and reporting rules vary by location.

Notochord

A flexible embryonic rod that guides axial development and largely disappears as the vertebral column forms.

Novel Biomarkers of Kidney Function

Emerging blood, urine, or tissue measurements intended to detect kidney injury or altered filtration earlier or more specifically than serum creatinine alone. Examples include selected tubular-injury proteins, but clinical usefulness depends on validation, timing, and the patient's context.

NOWS

Alternate name; see *Neonatal Opioid Withdrawal Syndrome*.

Noxious

Harmful, poisonous, or capable of causing tissue injury or pain. Noxious stimuli activate protective sensory pathways such as pain and withdrawal reflexes.

NPS

Abbreviation for nail-patella syndrome, an inherited disorder affecting nails, kneecaps, elbows, pelvis, eyes, and sometimes kidneys; see *Nail-Patella Syndrome*.

NREM Sleep

The part of sleep without rapid eye movements, ranging from light sleep to deep slow-wave sleep. It alternates with REM sleep in repeated cycles and supports physical restoration, learning, and memory.

NS

Abbreviation commonly used for Noonan syndrome, a genetic condition with characteristic facial features, short stature, congenital heart disease, bleeding tendency, or developmental differences; see *Noonan Syndrome*.

NSAID

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used to reduce pain, fever, and inflammation. Examples include ibuprofen and naproxen; these medicines can irritate the stomach, cause bleeding or kidney problems, and increase heart risks in some people.

Alternate Names:
Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug

NSAID-Induced Ulcers

Alternate name; see *Peptic Ulcer*.

NSTEMI

A heart attack in which a blocked or narrowed coronary artery injures heart muscle but does not produce the typical persistent ST-segment elevation on an ECG. It may cause chest pressure, breathlessness, sweating, nausea, or faintness.

Alternate Names:
Non-ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction

NTD

NTD commonly means neural-tube defect, a congenital brain or spinal-cord malformation associated with inadequate folate and other factors.

Nuchal

Relating to the back of the neck. Nuchal rigidity means painful or limited neck bending and can occur with meningitis or bleeding around the brain. Nuchal translucency is a first-trimester ultrasound measurement used to estimate certain pregnancy risks.

Nuchal Cord

Wrapping of the umbilical cord around the fetal neck, occurring once or more times. It is common and often harmless; fetal heart-rate abnormalities

can occur during labor in some cases.

Nuchal Rigidity

Stiffness or pain that makes it difficult to bend the neck forward. It may occur with meningitis, bleeding around the brain, severe muscle problems, or other illnesses; sudden stiffness with fever or severe headache may signal a serious condition.

Nuchal Translucency Screening

An ultrasound measurement of the clear space at the back of a fetus's neck, usually performed early in pregnancy. A larger-than-expected measurement can indicate increased risk of chromosome or heart problems but is not a diagnosis.

Nuchal Translucency Test

An early-pregnancy ultrasound measurement of the clear space at the back of the fetus's neck. It estimates the chance of certain chromosome or structural problems but cannot diagnose them; abnormal results may lead to additional testing.

Nuclear

Relating to the nucleus of a cell, the center of an atom, or medical tests and treatments that use radioactivity. The intended meaning depends on the surrounding medical context.

Nuclear Factor Kappa B

A ubiquitous inducible master transcription factor complex that coordinates immune and inflammatory responses, cell survival, and cytokine transcription; normally held inactive in the cytoplasm by I-kappa-B inhibitor proteins until activated by inflammatory cytokines, bacterial LPS, or viral infection.

Alternate Names:
NF-kappaB; NF-kB

Nuclear Medicine

A medical specialty that uses radiopharmaceuticals for diagnostic imaging and targeted treatment. Diagnostic tracers reveal body function or chemical activity, while therapeutic agents deliver radiation to selected tissues. Common imaging methods include PET and SPECT.

Nuclear Medicine Imaging

Imaging that uses a radioactive tracer and a specialized detector to show organ function, blood flow, chemical activity, or disease distribution. Common examples include PET, SPECT, bone scans, thyroid scans, and radionuclide cardiac imaging.

Nuclear Medicine Scan

A diagnostic imaging examination that uses small amounts of radiopharmaceuticals and a gamma camera to visualize organ physiology and metabolism; see *Nuclear Medicine*.

Nuclear Pore Complex

A large, multiprotein cylindrical channel spanning the double-membrane nuclear envelope, composed of multiple nucleoporin proteins that regulate and mediate the selective bidirectional transport of macromolecules (RNA, ribonucleoproteins, proteins) between the nucleus and the cytoplasm.

Alternate Names:
NPC

Nuclear Sclerosis

A common age-related cataract in which the center of the eye's lens gradually becomes yellow and hard. It can slowly blur vision, reduce contrast, or alter color perception and is treated when it interferes with daily activities.

Nuclear Stress Test

A test that compares blood flow to heart muscle at rest and during exercise or medicine-induced stress using a radioactive tracer. It can identify areas of reduced perfusion that suggest coronary artery disease.

Nuclear Ventriculography

A heart scan that follows a small radioactive tracer through the bloodstream to measure how much blood the heart pumps with each beat and whether the heart walls move normally.

Nucleic Acid

DNA or RNA, the molecules that store, copy, and

use genetic instructions. DNA usually stores the long-term information, while RNA helps read those instructions and make proteins or perform other jobs in cells.

Nucleic Acid Hybridization

A laboratory method in which matching DNA or RNA strands bind together. This allows a test to find, identify, or measure a particular genetic sequence from a person, tumor, or infectious organism.

Nucleolus

A dense region within the cell nucleus where ribosomal RNA is produced and ribosome subunits begin assembly.

Nucleoside

A small molecule made of a nitrogen-containing base joined to a sugar. Adding one or more phosphate groups makes a nucleotide, the building block used to make DNA or RNA and to carry energy in cells.

Nucleoside Analogs

Medicines that resemble the building blocks used to make DNA or RNA. Some viruses use them by mistake, which interrupts viral copying; the medicine chosen depends on the virus, illness, kidney function, and other factors.

Nucleotide

A small molecule made of a sugar, a nitrogen-containing base, and one or more phosphate groups. Nucleotides build DNA and RNA and also carry energy used by cells.

Nucleus

The membrane-bound cell organelle containing most genetic material, or a defined cluster of neurons in the central nervous system.

Nucleus Accumbens

A group of nerve cells deep in the brain that helps process reward, motivation, learning, and reinforcement. Its activity is involved in normal behavior and in disorders such as addiction and some psychiatric illnesses.

Nucleus Ambiguus

A group of motor neurons in the medulla that supplies striated muscles of the palate, pharynx, and larynx, chiefly through the glossopharyngeal and vagus nerves. It also contains neurons contributing to cardiac parasympathetic control. Its motor output supports swallowing, speech, and vocalization.

Nucleus Pulposus

The soft, gel-like center of a spinal disk, surrounded by a tough outer ring. It helps spread pressure between vertebrae, but a tear may allow it to bulge or press on nerves.

Nulligravida

An obstetric term for a person who has never been pregnant. It is different from nullipara, which means never having given birth beyond the stage of pregnancy used in a particular medical record system.

Nullipara

A person who has never carried a pregnancy beyond the stage of fetal viability; the adjective is nulliparous.

Null Mutation

A genetic change that prevents a gene from producing a functional protein or RNA. The effect depends on the gene, the other copy, and whether the change occurs in body cells or reproductive cells.

Numb

Numb means lacking normal sensation or emotional responsiveness; physical numbness can result from nerve, brain, circulation, metabolic, or medication-related problems.

Number Needed To Harm

The estimated number of people who must receive a treatment, rather than the comparison treatment, for one extra person to experience a specified harmful outcome during a stated period. A smaller num-

ber means the harm is more frequent.

Number Needed To Treat

The number of people who must receive an intervention for one additional person to experience the specified beneficial outcome compared with the control over a defined time. It is the reciprocal of absolute risk reduction.

Numbness

Numbness is reduced or absent sensation, often from nerve compression, neuropathy, stroke, spinal disease, circulation problems, or anesthetic effects.

Numbness And Tingling

Reduced sensation or prickling, often caused by nerve compression, neuropathy, spinal disease, vitamin deficiency, altered circulation, or other neurologic disorders. The pattern may be localized or widespread and can occur with weakness, pain, or changes in coordination, depending on the underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Paresthesia; Pins and Needles

Numbness In Hands

Reduced or absent sensation in one or both hands, commonly caused by nerve compression, neuropathy, injury, circulation problems, or systemic disease.

Nummular

Coin-shaped or round. The term is commonly used for nummular eczema, which causes itchy, coin-shaped patches of inflamed skin.

Nummular Dermatitis

An inflammatory skin disorder characterized by itchy, coin-shaped patches, often on the arms or legs. Lesions may be dry, scaly, crusted, or weeping. Dry skin and local irritation can contribute, and similar-appearing eruptions include fungal infection and other eczematous disorders.

Nummular Eczema

An inflammatory skin condition causing intensely itchy, coin-shaped red patches, sometimes with blisters, crusting, or scaling, usually on the arms or legs. Dry skin, irritation, or injury can trigger it; similar rashes can have other causes.

Nursemaid's Elbow

Nursemaid's elbow is subluxation of the radial head after sudden traction on a young child's extended or pronated arm; the child avoids using the arm, and gentle clinician reduction usually restores movement.

Nurse Practitioner

A nurse practitioner is an advanced-practice nurse who can assess patients, diagnose and treat many conditions, prescribe medicines where authorized, and provide preventive care.

Nursery

A place or service for the care of infants, including specialized newborn care in a hospital.

Nursing

The professional practice of caring for people, promoting health, preventing illness, and supporting recovery or comfort.

Nursing Home

A residential facility that provides ongoing nursing care, assistance with daily activities, and medical or rehabilitation services for people who cannot live independently.

Nursing Home Acquired Pneumonia

Pneumonia occurring in a person living in a nursing home or other long-term-care setting. Residence in long-term care alone is not considered a separate category for predicting antibiotic-resistant infection; risk depends on the person's clinical factors.

Nut Allergies

An immune-mediated reaction to one or more tree nuts or peanuts. Reactions range from hives or gastrointestinal symptoms to life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Nut Allergy; Nut-Allergy

Nutation

A nodding or rocking movement; in anatomy it commonly describes movement of the sacrum relative to the pelvis.

Nutcracker Esophagus

An older manometry term for unusually strong but coordinated contractions of the esophagus, which may cause chest pain or difficulty swallowing. Current classifications generally use *hypercontractile esophagus*; evaluation also considers reflux and other causes of symptoms.

Nutcracker Syndrome

Symptoms caused by compression of the left renal vein, usually between the aorta and the superior mesenteric artery, which impairs blood drainage from the kidney. It may cause blood or protein in the urine, left flank or pelvic pain, or enlarged pelvic veins or a varicocele. Compression seen on imaging without related symptoms is called nutcracker phenomenon; diagnosis requires matching symptoms with imaging and excluding other causes. Mild cases may be observed, while persistent severe symptoms may warrant vascular intervention.

Nutrient

A substance the body needs for energy, growth, repair, or normal function. Nutrients include protein, fats, carbohydrates, vitamins, minerals, and water; too little or too much of some nutrients can cause illness.

Nutrigenomics

The study of how food and nutrients interact with genes and how genetic differences influence responses to diet. It is used in research on metabolism and disease risk; many proposed personalized-nutrition applications remain under study.

Nutrition

How the body takes in, digests, absorbs, and uses food and its nutrients for health.

Nutritional Anemia

Anemia caused by inadequate intake, absorption, or use of nutrients needed for red-cell production, especially iron, vitamin B12, or folate.

Nutritional Assessment

A structured evaluation of food intake, body measurements, laboratory results, symptoms, and health conditions. It identifies nutritional problems and guides a safe, individualized eating plan or nutrition support.

Nutritional Deficiency

A lack of a vitamin, mineral, protein, energy, or other nutrient needed for normal body function. It may result from inadequate intake, poor absorption, increased needs, or disease and can impair growth, blood formation, immunity, nerves, or other organs.

Nutritional Dermatoses

Skin changes caused by too little or too much of a nutrient. For example, vitamin C deficiency can cause easy bruising and bleeding gums, while niacin deficiency can cause a sun-sensitive rash, diarrhea, and confusion.

Nutritional Disorders

Health problems caused by too little, too much, or poor use of nutrients. Examples include undernutrition, obesity, vitamin or mineral shortages, and problems caused by the body being unable to digest or absorb food properly.

Nutritional Rickets

Defective bone mineralization in a growing child caused by inadequate vitamin D, calcium, phosphate, or absorption, leading to bone pain, growth problems, or deformity; see *Rickets*.

Nutritional Screening

A brief check for risk of malnutrition using weight change, food intake, illness, and other factors. A concerning result leads to a fuller assessment and an individualized nutrition plan.

Nutrition-Focused Physical Examination

A structured examination for physical findings associated with malnutrition, including loss of subcutaneous fat, muscle wasting, edema, ascites, reduced functional status, and micronutrient-related signs. It complements dietary history, anthropometry, laboratory data, and disease assessment.

Nutrition In Pregnancy

Nutritional intake during pregnancy to support the pregnant person and growing fetus. Important nutrients include folate, iron, calcium, vitamin D, iodine, and protein; individual needs and supplements vary with diet and health.

Nutrition Risk Screening 2002

A hospital screening questionnaire that considers recent food intake, weight change, illness severity, and age to identify adults at risk of malnutrition. A high score prompts a fuller assessment; it is not itself a diagnosis.

Nutrition Support

Use of oral nutrition supplements, tube feeding, or intravenous nutrition when a person cannot meet nutritional needs by ordinary eating. The method depends on the digestive tract, illness, nutrition needs, and risks of treatment.

Nutritive

Providing nourishment that the body can use for energy, growth, repair, or normal function. Nutritive substances include protein, fat, carbohydrates, vitamins, minerals, and water.

Nux Vomica

The seed of Strychnos nux-vomica, containing strychnine and brucine; ingestion can cause severe convulsant poisoning.

Nyctalopia

Impaired vision in dim light or darkness, also called night blindness.

Alternate Names:
Night Blindness

NYHA Functional Classification

A four-class system describing how heart failure symptoms limit activity: class I causes no limitation, class II limits ordinary activity, class III limits less-than-ordinary activity, and class IV causes symptoms even at rest.

Nystagmus

Involuntary, repetitive eye movements that may be side-to-side, up-and-down, or rotary. It may be congenital or acquired and can occur with inner-ear disease, neurologic disorders, reduced vision, or medicines. The direction, pattern, and effect of gaze or head position can help distinguish its cause.

Nystagmus Benign Paroxysmal Positional

Positional nystagmus caused by movement of displaced inner-ear crystals, usually as part of benign paroxysmal positional vertigo; see *Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo*.

Nystagmus Retractorius

An unusual eye movement in which the eyes pull backward and may move toward each other when a person tries to look upward. It is a characteristic sign of a problem in the upper part of the brain, but other findings are needed to identify the cause.

Alternate Names:
Retraction-Convergence Nystagmus; Koerber-Salus-Elschnig Sign

O

OAB

Abbreviation; see *Overactive Bladder Syndrome*.

Ober Test

A hip examination maneuver sometimes used to assess tightness around the outer thigh. With the person lying on one side, the clinician moves the upper leg backward and outward, then checks whether it lowers toward the table. The test alone cannot confirm the cause of hip or thigh pain.

Alternate Names:
Ober's Test

Obesity

A chronic disease involving abnormal or excessive accumulation of body fat that may impair health. It is linked with a higher risk of conditions such as type 2 diabetes, high blood pressure, heart disease, stroke, sleep apnea, osteoarthritis, and some cancers. Many factors can contribute, including genes, metabolism, hormones, medicines, eating patterns, activity, environment, and social conditions; it is not caused by one factor or by lack of willpower alone. Body mass index (BMI) is commonly used to classify obesity in adults, but it does not measure body fat directly and is interpreted with other information.

Obesity Hypoventilation Syndrome

A syndrome defined by obesity, usually a body mass index of at least 30 kg/m^2, and elevated carbon dioxide while awake, typically an arterial carbon dioxide pressure of at least 45 mmHg, after other causes of hypoventilation are excluded. Sleep-disordered breathing, most often obstructive sleep apnea, commonly accompanies it. It may cause low blood oxygen, daytime sleepiness, and strain on the heart.

Obex Region

A small area at the lower end of the brain's fourth fluid-filled space, where it narrows into the central canal of the spinal cord. It lies near centers controlling breathing, swallowing, and vomiting.

OB/GYN

Abbreviation for obstetrics and gynecology, the medical specialties that care for pregnancy, childbirth, the period after birth, and the reproductive system.

Objective Response Rate

The percentage of people in a cancer study whose tumors shrink by a predefined amount or disappear during treatment. It does not show how long the response lasts or whether treatment improves survival.

Objects Or Insects In Ear

A foreign object or insect in the ear canal that may cause pain, reduced hearing, bleeding, discharge, or a sensation of movement. Objects touching the eardrum or lodged deeply can injure the ear canal or eardrum.

Alternate Names:
Aural Foreign Body; Foreign Body in Ear

Oblique Fracture

A break in a bone that runs diagonally across it.

Oblique Plane

A slice or view through the body or an organ at an

angle other than straight across. Medical imaging can use oblique planes to show structures that are difficult to see in standard horizontal, vertical, or front-to-back views.

Obliteration

Complete closing, destruction, or disappearance of a space, passage, or hollow channel in the body. It may result from scarring, inflammation, growth, injury, or treatment and can prevent normal movement of air, blood, fluid, or other contents.

Observation

Planned monitoring of a person, symptom, disease, or test result without immediate treatment or a procedure. The term may also describe watchful waiting, in which intervention is deferred while the clinical course is followed.

Obsession

A recurrent, intrusive, unwanted thought, image, or urge that causes distress and is difficult to control. Common themes include contamination, harm, mistakes, symmetry, or taboo subjects; having an obsession does not mean a person will act on it.

Obsessive-Compulsive And Related Disorders

A group of mental disorders involving recurrent intrusive thoughts, repetitive behaviors or mental acts, preoccupation with perceived appearance flaws, difficulty discarding possessions, or repetitive body-focused behaviors. Examples include obsessive-compulsive disorder, body dysmorphic disorder, hoarding disorder, trichotillomania, and excoriation disorder.

Obsessive Compulsive Disorder

Alternate spelling; see *Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder*.

Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder

A chronic mental health disorder characterized by recurring, unwanted, and intrusive thoughts, urges, or fears (obsessions) that produce significant anxiety, accompanied by repetitive physical actions or mental rituals (compulsions) that an individual feels compelled to perform to ease the distress or avert a feared event, causing marked disruption to daily functioning.

Alternate Names:
OCD

Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD)

Alternate name; see *Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder*.

Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder

A long-lasting pattern of excessive concern with order, rules, perfection, and control. It can make a person inflexible, slow to complete tasks, or unable to delegate and can interfere with relationships or work.

Obstetrical Forceps

Alternate spelling; see *Obstetric Forceps*.

Obstetric Anal Sphincter Injury

A third- or fourth-degree perineal tear during childbirth that involves the external or internal anal sphincter, with fourth-degree tears also extending through the anorectal mucosa. It can impair control of gas or stool and cause persistent pelvic-floor symptoms.

Obstetric Cholestasis

Alternate name; see *Intrahepatic Cholestasis Of Pregnancy*.

Obstetric Epidural Anesthesia

Pain relief during labor using medicine delivered through a thin catheter into the epidural space in the lower back. The medicine usually includes a local anesthetic and may include an opioid.

Alternate Names:
Epidural Analgesia in Labor; Labor Epidural; Obstetric Epidural

Obstetric Fistula

An abnormal passage between the vagina and blad-

der or rectum that develops after childbirth. The classic obstetric fistula follows prolonged obstructed labor, when sustained pressure from the fetus compresses pelvic tissues and causes ischemic injury and tissue death. It can cause continuous leakage of urine or stool, skin injury, recurrent infection, and substantial social consequences.

Obstetric Forceps

Paired curved instruments placed around the baby's head during selected assisted vaginal births to help guide delivery.

Alternate Names:
Delivery Forceps

Obstetrician

A medical doctor who cares for pregnant people during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postpartum period. Obstetricians manage routine and high-risk pregnancies, perform deliveries, and treat complications such as high blood pressure, diabetes, bleeding, or preterm labor.

Obstetric Nursing

Obstetric nursing provides care during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postpartum period, including monitoring, education, support, and recognition of complications.

Obstetrics

The branch of medicine concerned with care during pregnancy, labor, birth, and the weeks after birth, including routine care and treatment of complications affecting the pregnant person or baby.

Obstetrics and Gynaecology

The medical and surgical specialty combining obstetrics—the care of pregnancy, childbirth, and the postpartum period—with gynaecology, concerned with reproductive organs and health across life. It includes reproductive health, contraception, infertility, pregnancy, and childbirth.

Common name: Obstetrics and Gynecology

Obstetric Ultrasound

An ultrasound scan during pregnancy used to check the baby's age, growth, anatomy, position, heartbeat, and sometimes the placenta and fluid.

Obstipation

Severe constipation with inability to pass stool or gas. It can occur with a blockage in the intestine and may cause abdominal swelling, pain, vomiting, or serious illness.

Obstructed Infected Urinary System

A urinary tract obstruction with infection in the urine trapped above the blockage. The combination can rapidly damage the kidney or lead to sepsis.

Obstructed Labour

Failure of the fetus to pass through the birth canal despite adequate uterine contractions, commonly because of disproportion, abnormal presentation, or an obstructing lesion.

Obstruction

A blockage that prevents normal movement through a body passage, such as an airway, intestine, bile duct, blood vessel, or urinary tract. Causes include swelling, stones, scars, tumors, clots, and foreign objects.

Obstructive Azoospermia

Absence of sperm in the ejaculate because a reproductive duct is blocked or absent, despite sperm production in the testes. Causes include congenital absence of the vas deferens, vasectomy, scarring after infection, ejaculatory-duct obstruction, or surgical injury. Testicular size and reproductive hormone levels are often normal.

Alternate Names:
OA; Excretory Azoospermia

Obstructive Hydrocephalus

A buildup of cerebrospinal fluid caused by a blockage in its normal flow through the brain's ventricles.

Obstructive Hypertrophic

Cardiomyopathy

Alternate name; see *Hypertrophic Obstructive Cardiomyopathy*.

Obstructive Jaundice

Yellowing of the skin or eyes caused by blocked bile flow, usually in the bile ducts. Causes include gallstones, scarring, or a tumor. It may cause dark urine, pale stools, itching, or upper-abdominal pain; fever and chills may indicate infection of the bile ducts.

Obstructive Nephropathy

Kidney damage caused by a blockage that prevents urine from draining normally. Stones, tumors, scarring, an enlarged prostate, or birth-related problems can cause it; untreated blockage may lead to infection, permanent loss of kidney function, or kidney failure.

Obstructive Parotitis

Inflammation of a saliva gland near the ear because its drainage tube is blocked, often by a stone. Painful swelling usually worsens during meals, and trapped saliva can lead to repeated infection and tenderness.

Obstructive Shock

A life-threatening form of shock caused by a blockage that prevents the heart from filling or pumping blood properly. Causes include tension pneumothorax, cardiac tamponade, and a large pulmonary embolism. Findings may include very low blood pressure, a rapid heartbeat, and signs of impaired blood flow to organs.

Alternate Names:
Extracardiac Obstructive Shock

Obstructive Sleep Apnea

A common sleep disorder in which the muscles supporting the soft tissues in the back of the throat temporarily relax during sleep, narrowing or blocking the upper airway. This obstruction causes recurrent pauses in breathing, abrupt drops in blood oxygen levels, and brief awakenings, leading to loud disruptive snoring, morning headaches, unrefreshing sleep, and chronic daytime sleepiness, while increasing long-term cardiovascular risks.

Alternate Names:
OSA; Obstructive Sleep Apnea Syndrome (OSAS)

Obstructive Sleep Apnea Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Obstructive Sleep Apnea*.

Obstructive Uropathy

A blockage anywhere between the kidneys and the urethra that slows or stops urine flow. Stones, scarring, an enlarged prostate, tumors, or pressure from nearby tissue may cause it and can damage the kidneys if not relieved.

Obtund

To blunt or reduce alertness, responsiveness, or sensation; in clinical use, it often refers to reducing a person's level of alertness.

Obtundation

A state of reduced alertness and slowed responses, in which a person remains responsive to stronger voice or touch. It may result from illness, medicines, metabolic disturbance, poisoning, or brain disease.

Obtunded

Having reduced alertness and slowed responses but still responding to a loud voice or touch. It can result from medicines, illness, metabolic problems, poisoning, or brain disease.

Obturator

Relating to a structure that closes an opening. In the pelvis, the obturator nerve helps control muscles that draw the thigh inward and carries feeling from part of the inner thigh; the obturator artery supplies nearby muscles.

Obturator Canal

A short passage in the pelvic bone through which the obturator nerve and blood vessels travel from the pelvis to the inner thigh.

Obturator Foramen

A large opening in each side of the pelvis, mostly covered by a strong membrane. The obturator canal is a small passage at its upper edge for a nerve and blood vessels.

Obturator Hernia

A rare hernia in which part of the intestine pushes through an opening in the pelvic bone. It can block the bowel and may cause pain in the inner thigh.

Obturator Nerve

A nerve from the lumbar plexus that supplies muscles responsible for bringing the thigh inward and carries sensation from part of the inner thigh.

Obturator Sign

A physical examination finding in acute appendicitis or pelvic peritonitis; with the patient supine, passive internal rotation of the flexed right hip stretches the obturator internus muscle against the inflamed pelvic appendix, provoking acute right lower quadrant or pelvic pain.

Alternate Names:
Cope's Obturator Test; Obturator Internus Sign

Obtuse Marginal Artery

A branch of the circumflex coronary artery that runs along the outer border of the heart and supplies part of the left ventricle. Its size and number vary between people; blockage can cause a heart attack.

Occipital

Relating to the back of the head, the occipital bone, or the occipital lobe. These structures protect and support the brain and help process visual information and head or neck movement.

Occipital Bone

The bone at the back and base of the skull. It surrounds the opening where the spinal cord joins the brain and connects with the first neck vertebra.

Occipital Diastasis

Widening or separation of a joint between bones at the back of a newborn's skull. It may follow difficult birth or abnormal development, and imaging assesses its extent and associated injury.

Occipital Hematoma

A collection of blood in the scalp or tissues over the back of the head, usually after blunt trauma. It may cause a tender, localized swelling and can occur with other scalp, skull, or intracranial injuries.

Occipital Lobe

The part of the brain at the back of the head that receives and interprets visual signals. Injury or disease may cause missing areas of vision, difficulty recognizing objects, or visual hallucinations.

Occipital Neuralgia

Brief attacks of sharp, stabbing, or electric-shock pain caused by irritation of nerves at the back of the head. Pain may spread from the upper neck across the scalp and can be associated with tenderness or sensitivity to touch.

Occiput

The back part of the skull and the back of the head. It protects the rear of the brain and includes the occipital bone, which joins the skull base and neck.

Occiput Posterior Position

A position during labor in which the back of the baby's head faces the pregnant person's back. It can cause back pain or slow descent, although many babies rotate to a better position during labor.

Occiput Transverse Position

A fetal head position in which the back of the baby's head faces the pregnant person's side. It often rotates during labor; if it persists, descent may be slow and assisted delivery or cesarean birth may be needed.

Occlude

To block or close a passage, vessel, airway, duct, or opening. An occlusion may be caused by a clot, stone, swelling, scar, tumor, foreign object, or de-

liberate medical treatment.

Occlusal Adjustment

Selective reshaping of tooth surfaces to improve how the upper and lower teeth meet and reduce abnormal contact or bite interference.

Occlusal Guard

A removable device worn over the teeth to protect them from grinding, clenching, or injury. A night guard may reduce tooth wear during sleep, while a sports mouthguard protects against blows; it does not treat every cause of jaw pain.

Occlusal Splint

A removable dental appliance that changes or protects tooth contact and may reduce effects of grinding, jaw-joint strain, or selected bite problems.

Occlusion

Partial or complete blockage of a blood vessel or body passage. It may be caused by a blood clot, plaque, pressure, swelling, or an intentional medical procedure; the effects depend on the location and can include reduced blood flow, pain, or organ damage.

Occlusive Vascular Disease

Disease in which narrowing or blockage of a blood vessel reduces or stops blood flow to tissues.

Occult

Hidden or not readily visible or detectable on routine examination. An occult disease or bleeding may be found only with imaging, microscopy, or laboratory testing.

Occult Blood

Blood that is not visible to the naked eye and is detected by laboratory testing. In stool, it may be detected by a chemical guaiac test or an immunochemical test; the method and specimen determine the collection instructions and possible dietary or medicine effects. A positive stool test indicates blood is present but does not establish its cause.

Occult Blood Screen

Alternate name; see *Fecal Occult Blood Test*.

Occult Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Slow or intermittent bleeding somewhere in the digestive tract that cannot be seen in the stool. It may cause iron-deficiency anemia, tiredness, or a positive stool blood test and can have many possible sources.

Occult Primary Cancer

Alternate name; see *Carcinoma Of Unknown Primary*.

Occupational Asthma

Asthma caused by workplace exposures, such as flour dust, latex, chemicals, or fumes, or recurrence of previously inactive asthma after such exposure. Symptoms may improve on days away from work and worsen during exposure. Asthma that began independently and is only worsened by work is called work-aggravated asthma.

Occupational COPD

Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease caused or worsened by repeated workplace exposure to dust, fumes, chemicals, smoke, or other inhaled hazards. It causes lasting airflow limitation, cough, phlegm, and breathlessness; smoking and other risks may also contribute.

Occupational Dermatoses

Skin diseases caused or worsened by workplace conditions, such as repeated wet work, chemicals, gloves, dust, plants, or friction. Common examples are irritant and allergic contact dermatitis, often affecting the hands. The pattern depends on the exposure, duration, and individual susceptibility.

Occupational Disease

An illness caused or significantly worsened by workplace exposures or conditions. Examples include asthma from dust, hearing loss from noise, skin disease from chemicals, and lung disease from harmful particles.

Occupational Exposure

Contact with a potentially harmful substance, energy source, or condition during work. Examples include radiation, chemicals, dust, noise, heat, infection, and repetitive strain. Risk depends on the hazard, amount, duration, and protective controls; monitoring and prevention are part of occupational health.

Occupational Exposure Limit

A concentration or level of a substance in the workplace set for a defined exposure period. Limits vary by substance and jurisdiction and may be legally enforceable or advisory.

Occupational Health

The medical field focused on preventing work-related illness, injury, and harmful exposure while supporting workers' health.

Occupational Hearing Loss

Hearing damage caused by repeated or prolonged workplace noise or ototoxic substances. It is usually permanent and may cause difficulty understanding speech, especially in background noise. The pattern and severity depend on the exposure, duration, and individual susceptibility.

Occupational Lung Disease

Lung disease caused or worsened by dusts, fumes, gases, vapors, fibers, or other exposures at work. Examples include occupational asthma, pneumoconiosis, hypersensitivity pneumonitis, and asbestos-related disease.

Occupational Rehabilitation

Assessment, treatment, and workplace support that help a person return to work or remain employed after illness, injury, or disability. It may include graded activity, skills training, equipment, job changes, and coordination with employers and clinicians.

Occupational Safety And Health

Rules and practices that protect workers from injuries, illness, dangerous exposures, and unsafe conditions. Measures include training, protective equipment, ventilation, safe procedures, health monitoring, and reporting or controlling workplace hazards.

Occupational Therapist

A healthcare professional who helps people perform daily activities through rehabilitation, adaptive techniques, environmental changes, and assistive equipment.

Occupational Therapy

Rehabilitation that helps a person perform daily activities, work, school, and other meaningful tasks after illness, injury, or disability. It may use exercises, practice, adaptive equipment, changes to the environment, and strategies for movement, thinking, or sensory problems.

Occupational Therapy Assessment

An evaluation of how illness, injury, disability, or development affects daily activities, school, work, and self-care. The therapist identifies strengths and barriers and recommends exercises, skills practice, equipment, or environmental changes.

OCD

Obsessive-compulsive disorder, a condition involving recurrent unwanted thoughts or urges and/or repetitive behaviors or mental acts that cause distress or interfere with daily life.

Alternate Names:
Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder

Ochre

A yellow-brown color or earth pigment. In medicine, ochre discoloration can describe yellow-brown skin or tissue changes caused by pigment, blood breakdown, chronic congestion, or other conditions.

Ochronosis

Blue-black or brown discoloration of cartilage, tendons, skin, or the whites of the eyes caused by buildup of a chemical called homogentisic acid. It is most often linked to the inherited disorder alkaptonuria and may cause arthritis.

OCP

OCP commonly means oral contraceptive pill, a medicine containing estrogen, progestin, or both to prevent pregnancy and sometimes treat menstrual disorders.

Octreoscan

Nuclear-medicine imaging using indium-111-labeled octreotide, which binds to somatostatin receptors. It can demonstrate receptor-positive neuroendocrine tumors and their distribution; it is an older form of somatostatin-receptor imaging.

Octreotide

Octreotide is a somatostatin analogue that suppresses growth hormone, several gastrointestinal hormones, and intestinal secretion; it is used for acromegaly, certain neuroendocrine tumors, and selected secretory diarrhoeas.

Ocular

Relating to the eye or vision. The term may describe an eye structure, examination, medicine, injury, infection, or disease affecting sight. Sudden severe pain or sudden loss of vision can indicate an ocular emergency.

Ocular Albinism

Ocular albinism is an inherited disorder with reduced pigment primarily in the eyes, causing decreased visual acuity, nystagmus, photophobia, and abnormal retinal development.

Ocular Bobbing

Repeated rapid downward movements of both eyes followed by a slower return toward the primary position. It is classically associated with dysfunction in the pons or other brainstem pathways.

Alternate Names:
Fast Downward Ocular Movement; Pontine Ocular Bobbing

Ocular Burns and Chemical Injuries

Injuries to the eye from chemicals, heat, radiation, or other agents. Damage may involve the conjunctiva, cornea, limbus, eyelids, or deeper structures and can threaten vision.

Ocular Cicatricial Pemphigoid

A chronic autoimmune disease that scars the conjunctiva, the membrane covering the white of the eye and lining the eyelids. It can cause eyelid scarring, lashes rubbing the eye, corneal damage, and vision loss; it may also affect other mucous membranes.

Ocular Fixation

The ability to hold the eyes steadily on a target; abnormal fixation can impair visual acuity, tracking, or alignment.

Ocular Flutter

An involuntary ocular motility disorder characterized by rapid, conjugate, horizontal saccadic oscillations without an intersaccadic pause around the point of visual fixation, occurring in paraneoplastic syndromes, viral encephalitis, and cerebellar dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Horizontal Saccadic Flutter

Ocular Foreign Body

A particle lodged on the conjunctiva or cornea, or penetrating the eyeball. It may cause pain, redness, tearing, or a foreign-body sensation; a penetrating object can damage internal eye structures.

Alternate Names:
Foreign Body in Eye

Ocular Gnathostomiasis

A rare form of visceral gnathostomiasis in which migrating *Gnathostoma* larvae invade tissues of the eye. Depending on the site, it can cause eyelid swelling, conjunctival or intraocular inflammation, bleeding, retinal scarring or detachment, and vision loss.

Ocular Histoplasmosis Syndrome

An eye condition linked to an earlier histoplasmosis infection. It can cause scars in the retina and, in some people, abnormal blood vessels that damage

central vision.

Ocular Hypertension

Higher-than-normal intraocular pressure (pressure inside the eye) without glaucomatous optic neuropathy (damage to the optic nerve) or visual-field loss. It is a risk state for glaucoma, but does not mean glaucoma is already present or certain to develop.

Ocular Hypotony

Abnormally low pressure inside the eye. The cutoff varies, but pressure around 5–6 mmHg or lower is often considered very low. Causes include reduced fluid production or excess fluid drainage; severe or lasting hypotony can damage the retina or other eye tissues.

Alternate Names:
Hypotony, Ocular; Ocular Hypotension; Low Eye Tension

Ocular Ischemic Syndrome

Eye findings caused by severely reduced blood flow through the arteries supplying the eye, usually from advanced carotid artery disease. It may cause gradual or sudden vision loss, eye pain, retinal changes, or abnormal new blood vessels.

Ocular Larva Migrans

Eye infection caused by migrating larvae of *Toxocara* roundworms, usually affecting one eye. It can cause inflammation inside the eye, a white pupil, reduced vision, crossed eyes, or retinal damage. Diagnosis uses the eye findings, exposure history, and sometimes blood tests.

Ocular Melanoma

A malignant tumor of pigment-producing melanocytes in the eye. Most primary intraocular melanomas arise in the uvea, comprising the iris, ciliary body, and choroid; melanoma can also arise in the conjunctiva. Uveal tumors may be asymptomatic initially and can spread through the bloodstream, most often to the liver.

Ocular Migraine

An imprecise term often used for visual aura with migraine, which usually affects both eyes because it arises in the brain. True retinal migraine causes reversible visual symptoms in one eye and is rare; temporary vision loss can also have other causes.

Ocular Motility

The ability of the eyes to move together in a coordinated way. Abnormal eye movements or poor alignment can cause double vision, eyestrain, dizziness, or reduced vision and may result from muscle, nerve, brain, or eye disease.

Ocular Myasthenia Gravis

A form of myasthenia gravis in which weakness affects only the muscles that move the eyes and lift the eyelids. It causes drooping eyelids or double vision that worsens with use and improves with rest. Symptoms may later spread to swallowing, speech, breathing, or limb muscles.

Alternate Names:
OMG; Ocular MG

Ocular Myiasis

Infestation of the eye or nearby tissues by fly larvae. It can cause pain, irritation, tearing, and vision problems.

Ocular Oncology

The ophthalmic subspecialty concerned with tumors of the eye and surrounding structures, including the uvea, retina, conjunctiva, eyelids, and orbit. It evaluates both benign and malignant ocular tumors and coordinates diagnosis and tumor-directed care with pathology, radiology, and other cancer specialists.

Ocular Orbit

The bony cavity around the eye. It contains the eyeball, eye-movement muscles, nerves, blood vessels, glands, and protective tissues.

Ocular Pain

Pain in or around the eye caused by surface irritation, infection, inflammation, injury, glaucoma, or disease of tissues surrounding the eye. It may be accompanied by redness, tearing, light sensitivity, visual change, or pain with eye movement, depending

on the cause.

Ocular Rosacea

Rosacea affecting the eyelids or surface of the eyes, causing burning, redness, a gritty feeling, dryness, or light sensitivity. Persistent inflammation can affect the cornea and may impair the eye surface.

Ocular Surface Disease

A group of conditions affecting the eye's surface, eyelids, or tears, including dry eye and eyelid inflammation. Symptoms may include burning, redness, irritation, and blurred or changing vision.

Ocular Toxoplasmosis

A retinal infection or inflammation caused by Toxoplasma gondii, which can produce blurred vision, floaters, pain, and recurrent retinal scars.

Oculocardiac Reflex

A slowing of the heartbeat or similar body response caused by pressure or pulling on the eye or tissues around it.

Oculocephalic Reflex

A brainstem reflex sometimes tested in an unconscious person by moving the head. In people who cannot focus their eyes, the eyes normally move opposite to the head movement. The response provides information about brainstem pathways and is interpreted with other examination findings.

Oculocerebrorenal Syndrome

An older name for Lowe syndrome, a rare X-linked disorder caused by changes in the *OCRL* gene. It primarily affects the eyes, brain, and kidneys and commonly causes congenital cataracts, low muscle tone, developmental impairment, and progressive kidney dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Lowe Syndrome; Lowe Oculocerebrorenal Syndrome

Oculocutaneous Albinism

A group of inherited conditions in which reduced melanin affects the skin, hair, and eyes. Vision findings vary by type; reduced pigmentation can increase sensitivity to sunlight and the risk of skin damage and skin cancer.

Oculogyric Crisis

A prolonged, involuntary upward turning of the eyes, often caused by a medicine or neurologic disorder.

Oculomotor Nerve

The third cranial nerve, controlling most eye movements, eyelid lifting, and pupil narrowing. Damage can cause double vision, a drooping eyelid, an outward-turning eye, or an abnormally enlarged pupil.

Oculomotor Nerve Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of muscles supplied by the third cranial nerve, causing eyelid drooping, double vision, abnormal eye position, and sometimes a dilated pupil.

Oculomotor Nucleus

A group of nerve cells in the midbrain that controls most eye movements, lifts the upper eyelid, and narrows the pupil through the third cranial nerve.

Oculopharyngeal Muscular Dystrophy

An inherited muscle disease that usually begins in middle age and gradually weakens the eyelids and throat muscles. Drooping eyelids and difficulty swallowing are typical; weakness of the hips and shoulders may develop later. Most cases result from a repeat expansion in the *PABPN1* gene.

Alternate Names:
OPMD

Oculoplastic Procedures

Operations on the eyelids, tear ducts, eye socket, or nearby facial tissues to restore function, repair injury, remove disease, or change appearance. Risks include bleeding, infection, scarring, dry eyes, and rarely injury affecting vision.

Oculoplastic Surgery

An ophthalmic surgical subspecialty concerned with

disorders of the eyelids, orbit, tear drainage system, and nearby facial tissues. It includes reconstructive, functional, and selected cosmetic surgery.

Alternate Names:
Oculoplastics and Orbital Surgery; Oculofacial Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery; Ophthalmic Plastic Surgery

Oculosympathetic Palsy

Alternate name; see *Horner's Syndrome*.

Oculovestibular Reflex

A brainstem reflex tested by stimulating the balance organs in the inner ear. In an unconscious person with an intact brainstem, cold water in the ear canal normally causes both eyes to drift slowly toward that side; the response is interpreted with other examination findings.

Alternate Names:
Caloric Vestibulo-Ocular Reflex

ODD

Abbreviation; see *Oppositional Defiant Disorder*.

Odontalgia

Pain coming from a tooth or the tissues around it. Common causes include decay, a cracked tooth, infection, gum disease, or injury; swelling, fever, difficulty swallowing, or severe pain can indicate spreading infection or other significant disease.

Odontoblast

A cell along the inner part of a tooth that makes dentin, the hard layer beneath enamel. Odontoblasts produce dentin while teeth develop and can make limited repairs after injury.

Odontoclast

A cell that breaks down the hard tissues of a tooth. This process helps baby teeth be shed naturally, but unwanted tooth resorption can weaken a tooth and may follow injury, inflammation, pressure, or other disease.

Odontodysplasia

Odontodysplasia is abnormal development of tooth enamel and dentin, producing thin, weak, discolored teeth that may erupt late or be easily damaged.

Odontogenesis

The process by which teeth form and develop before and after birth. Problems during development can cause missing teeth, weak enamel, abnormal dentin, or changes in tooth shape and eruption.

Odontogenic Cutaneous Fistula

An abnormal tunnel from an infected tooth to the skin, usually on the chin, cheek, or jaw. It may appear as a small draining opening; treating the tooth infection usually closes the tunnel.

Odontogenic Cyst

A fluid-filled sac arising from tissues involved in tooth development, usually within the jaw. It may be painless or cause swelling, tooth displacement, infection, or bone damage.

Odontogenic Fibroma

An odontogenic fibroma is a rare benign tumor arising from tooth-forming connective tissue, usually presenting as a jaw lesion.

Odontogenic Infection

An infection arising from a tooth or the tissues around it, usually caused by dental caries, pulp infection, gum disease, or trauma. It may form an abscess and spread into the jaw, face, neck, or bloodstream.

Odontogenic Keratocyst

A cyst that develops in the jaw from tooth-forming tissue. It may grow into bone without causing symptoms, can recur after removal, and is sometimes associated with an inherited skin-cancer syndrome; imaging and tissue examination guide treatment.

Odontogenic Keratocyst Pathology

An odontogenic cyst typically lined by a thin, uniform parakeratinized stratified squamous epithelium

with a palisaded basal layer. Satellite cysts and a tendency to recur may be present.

Odontogenic Neoplasm

An odontogenic neoplasm is a growth arising from tissues involved in tooth formation, usually in the jaw; it may be benign or malignant.

Odontogenic Tumors and Cysts

Alternate name; see *Jaw Tumors And Cysts*.

Odontoid Process

A peg-like projection from the second neck vertebra that fits into the first neck vertebra and allows the head to turn from side to side.

Odontoma

A noncancerous overgrowth of tooth-forming tissue, usually found in the jaw and often discovered when a permanent tooth fails to erupt. It may look like several small teeth or a solid calcified mass and is usually removed if it blocks eruption.

Odontopathy

Any disease or abnormality affecting a tooth or the tissues supporting it. Examples include tooth decay, gum disease, infection, abnormal tooth development, wear, and injury. Untreated dental infection can spread to surrounding tissues and occasionally to the bloodstream.

Odynophagia

Pain when swallowing, often felt as burning, squeezing, or a sticking sensation in the throat or chest. Causes include infection, reflux, ulcers, medicines, injury, and other swallowing-tube disorders.

Oedema

British spelling of edema: abnormal fluid accumulation in tissues that causes swelling. Causes include injury, infection, venous disease, heart or kidney failure, medicines, and lymphatic blockage.

Oesophageal

Relating to the oesophagus, the muscular tube carrying swallowed material from the pharynx to the stomach.

Oesophageal Atresia

A birth defect in which the swallowing tube ends blindly instead of connecting normally to the stomach. A baby may drool, cough, choke, or turn blue during feeds; treatment involves surgery, especially when an abnormal connection to the airway is also present.

Oesophageal Ulcer

An open sore in the swallowing tube between the throat and stomach. Reflux, infection, medicines, corrosive injury, inflammation, or cancer may cause it, leading to painful swallowing, chest pain, bleeding, or difficulty swallowing.

Oesophageal Varices

Enlarged fragile veins in the wall of the swallowing tube, usually caused by high pressure in the liver's circulation. They may cause no symptoms until they rupture, leading to vomiting blood or black stools and a life-threatening emergency.

Oesophagitis

Alternate spelling; see *Esophagitis*.

Oesophagoscopy

Examination of the food pipe using a thin viewing tube passed through the mouth. It can investigate swallowing difficulty, pain, bleeding, or abnormal tissue, and can remove a foreign body, take samples, stop bleeding, or widen a narrowing. Sedation or anesthesia is usually used.

Oesophagus

The muscular tube that transports swallowed food and liquid from the pharynx to the stomach.

Oestradiol

British spelling of estradiol, the main naturally occurring estrogen during the reproductive years. It supports reproductive development, the menstrual cycle, bone health, and other body functions.

Oestriol

A form of estrogen made in large amounts during pregnancy by the placenta using substances from the fetus and pregnant person. Its level can be measured in some prenatal screening tests, but it is not interpreted alone to diagnose a problem.

Oestrogen

British spelling; see *Estrogen*.

Oestrogen Replacement Therapy

Treatment with estrogen, sometimes combined with a progestogen, to relieve symptoms caused by low estrogen such as hot flushes and vaginal dryness. Benefits and risks depend on age, medical history, uterus status, dose, and route, so treatment is individualized.

Oestrogens

British spelling; see *Estrogens*.

Oestrone

A form of estrogen made by the ovaries and by conversion of other hormones in body tissues. It becomes the main estrogen after menopause and affects reproductive tissues, bones, blood vessels, and metabolism.

Ofatumumab

A monoclonal antibody that targets CD20 on B cells. It is used to treat adults with relapsing forms of multiple sclerosis and has also been used for selected blood cancers; it can lower B-cell numbers and increase infection risk.

Off-Label

Use of an approved medicine for an indication, dose, route, or population not specified in its regulatory approval.

Off-Label Use

Use of an approved medicine for a condition, dose, route, or age group not specifically included in its official approval. A clinician may choose it when evidence and expected benefits support its use.

Offspring

The young or descendants produced by one organism or by a pair. In medicine and genetics, offspring may be studied to understand inherited traits, pregnancy outcomes, developmental conditions, and disease risk.

Ofloxacin

A fluoroquinolone antibiotic used for selected susceptible bacterial infections. It can cause serious tendon, nerve, heart-rhythm, and other adverse effects.

Ogilvie'S Syndrome

Another spelling of Ogilvie syndrome: severe widening of the large intestine without a physical blockage, often after surgery or during serious illness. Rising pressure can reduce blood flow or cause a bowel perforation.

Ogilvie Syndrome

A dangerous widening of the large intestine without a physical blockage, usually in a seriously ill or recently operated patient. Abdominal swelling, pain, nausea, or failure to pass stool may occur, and the bowel can perforate if untreated.

Ohm

The standard unit of electrical resistance, equal to one volt per ampere. In medical equipment, resistance affects how electrical current flows through devices, sensors, wires, and body tissues.

OHSS

Abbreviation; see *Ovarian Hyperstimulation Syndrome*.

Oidium

A fragment or spore-like fungal element formed by fragmentation of a hypha; the term is also used in older fungal classifications.

Oil

A hydrophobic liquid used as a nutrient, solvent, emollient, or medicinal preparation; safety depends

on the specific oil.

Oil Red O

A fat-soluble histologic dye used to stain neutral lipids red in tissue. It is commonly used on frozen sections because routine tissue processing can remove much of the lipid.

Alternate Names:
Oil-Red-O

Oily Hair

Hair that appears greasy because the scalp produces excess oil or because of product buildup. It may occur with infrequent washing, hormonal changes, or some skin conditions and is not poisoning.

Oily Skin

Skin that produces more oil than usual, often causing shine, enlarged-looking pores, or acne. It may occur with hormonal changes, genetics, or some skin conditions; persistent acne or irritation can have other underlying causes.

Ointment

A thick, semisolid preparation applied to the skin, inside the nose, or other body surfaces. Its oily base helps protect the area and keep it moist; some ointments also contain medicines that treat infection, inflammation, pain, or other conditions.

Ointment Bases

Semisolid materials that carry medicines applied to the skin or moist body surfaces. They affect how easily a product spreads, how much moisture it retains, how much medicine enters tissue, and how long it remains stable.

Okadaic Acid

A toxin made by certain marine organisms that can accumulate in shellfish. Eating contaminated shellfish may cause diarrhoea and vomiting; in laboratories it is used to study enzymes that remove phosphate groups from proteins.

Okihiro Syndrome

A rare inherited condition caused by changes in the SALL4 gene. It may combine abnormalities of the thumb or forearm with difficulty moving the eyes, and may also affect hearing, the heart, kidneys, or spine.

Olanzapine

Olanzapine is an atypical antipsychotic that blocks dopamine and serotonin receptors and treats schizophrenia and bipolar disorder; weight gain, diabetes, dyslipidaemia, sedation, and movement disorders are important risks.

Olaparib

Olaparib is a PARP inhibitor used for selected cancers with BRCA or other homologous-recombination repair defects; anaemia, nausea, fatigue, myelosuppression, and rare myelodysplastic syndrome or acute myeloid leukaemia may occur.

Old Age

Later life, a period associated with wide variation in physical function, chronic illness, cognition, and social circumstances.

Oleander Poisoning

Poisoning from eating oleander, which contains toxins that affect the heart. Nausea, vomiting, dizziness, confusion, slow or irregular heartbeat, fainting, or seizures may occur.

Olecranon

The prominent bony process at the proximal end of the ulna forming the point of the elbow.

Olecranon Bursitis

Inflammation of the subcutaneous synovial bursa overlying the olecranon process of the ulna, presenting with fluctuant, localized swelling over the posterior elbow, provoked by repetitive trauma ("student's elbow"), gout, or bacterial infection (septic bursitis).

Alternate Names:
Student Elbow; Miner Elbow

Olecranon Fossa

A deep triangular depression on the posterior surface of the distal humerus superior to the trochlea that accommodates the curved olecranon process of the ulna during full elbow extension.

Oleic Acid

A monounsaturated fat found in olive oil, nuts, seeds, avocados, and many other foods. Replacing some saturated fats with it may support healthier blood cholesterol levels as part of a balanced diet.

Oleum

A very corrosive mixture of sulfur trioxide and sulfuric acid, used industrially and dangerous to skin, eyes, and lungs.

Olfaction

The sense of smell. Odor molecules stimulate special cells in the upper part of the nose, which send signals to the brain to identify and perceive odors.

Olfactory

Relating to the sense of smell or the nerves and brain pathways that process odors. Problems in this system can cause reduced smell, loss of smell, distorted smells, or unusual odor sensations.

Olfactory Bulb

The olfactory bulb is a forebrain structure that receives signals from nasal smell receptors and begins processing odor information.

Olfactory Cortex

The olfactory cortex is a group of brain regions that interprets smell signals and links them with memory, emotion, and behavior.

Olfactory Gyrus

The olfactory gyrus is a cortical region associated with processing olfactory information and includes areas near the medial temporal and frontal lobes.

Olfactory Learning

Olfactory learning is acquisition or modification of behavior or memory through exposure to odors and their associations.

Olfactory Mucosa

The olfactory mucosa is specialized nasal lining containing receptor neurons, supporting cells, and glands that detect odor molecules.

Olfactory Nerve

The first cranial nerve, which carries smell signals from specialized cells high in the nose to the brain. Injury or disease can reduce or eliminate the sense of smell or distort odors.

Olfactory Neuroblastoma

A rare malignant tumor arising in the upper nasal cavity near the olfactory nerves, often causing nasal blockage, nosebleeds, or reduced smell.

Olfactory Tract

The olfactory tract is a bundle of nerve fibers carrying smell information from the olfactory bulb to cerebral regions involved in odor perception.

Olfactory Tubercle

The olfactory tubercle is a ventral forebrain region involved in odor processing, reward, motivation, and integration with limbic circuits.

Oligoasthenoteratozoospermia

A semen abnormality in which sperm numbers are low, movement is reduced, and fewer sperm have a typical shape. It can reduce fertility and may result from testicular disease, hormone problems, heat, medicines, smoking, or an unknown cause. Repeat semen testing and evaluation help guide treatment or assisted reproduction.

Alternate Names:
OAT Syndrome; OAT

Oligoclonal Bands

Distinct bands of immunoglobulins, usually IgG, detected by laboratory testing of cerebrospinal fluid and compared with a blood sample. Bands present in cerebrospinal fluid but not blood indicate anti-

body production within the central nervous system; they occur in multiple sclerosis and other infectious or inflammatory conditions and are not specific to multiple sclerosis.

Oligocythaemia

An obsolete term for a red blood cell count below the reference range. It is not itself a definition of anemia, which is identified by a low hemoglobin concentration relative to the appropriate reference range.

Oligodendrocyte

A supporting cell in the central nervous system that forms myelin around axons. Myelin helps nerve signals travel quickly; oligodendrocytes can be damaged in disorders such as multiple sclerosis.

Oligodendroglia

Oligodendroglia are glial cells of the central nervous system that produce myelin around axons and support nerve conduction.

Oligodendroglial Neoplasm

An older descriptive term for a brain tumor whose cells resemble oligodendrocytes, the cells that form myelin around nerve fibers. It is not a precise current diagnosis: an oligodendroglioma is classified by an IDH gene mutation and deletion of chromosome arms 1p and 19q, while other tumors with similar-looking cells receive different diagnoses.

Oligodendroglioma

A diffuse glioma defined by an IDH1 or IDH2 mutation and whole-arm codeletion of chromosomes 1p and 19q. It most often arises in the cerebral hemispheres and may cause seizures or other neurologic symptoms. Histologic grade and clinical features influence its behavior.

Oligodontia

Congenital absence of six or more permanent teeth, usually excluding the third molars. It may occur alone or with a genetic syndrome and can affect chewing, speech, appearance, and jaw development. The number and pattern of missing teeth help distinguish it from hypodontia and anodontia.

Oligogenic Inheritance

A pattern in which changes in a small number of genes work together to influence a disease or characteristic. The combination and strength of the changes can make symptoms differ among affected people.

Oligohydramnios

A lower-than-expected amount of amniotic fluid during pregnancy, commonly identified on ultrasound by a deepest vertical fluid pocket of less than 2 cm. Causes include leaking membranes, placental problems, fetal kidney or urinary-tract conditions, or a pregnancy continuing beyond the due date.

Oligomenorrhea

Infrequent menstrual periods. In adults more than three years after the first period, cycles longer than 35 days or fewer than 8 cycles a year are commonly considered irregular; definitions vary with age and time since menstruation began. Causes include ovulation disorders, polycystic ovary syndrome, endocrine disease, undernutrition, excessive exercise, or perimenopause.

Oligomenorrhea (Infrequent Menstruation)

Alternate name; see *Oligomenorrhea*.

Oligomenorrhoea

British spelling; see *Oligomenorrhea*.

Oligometastasis

A state in which cancer has spread to a limited number of sites that may be suitable for treatment directed at each site. The number used to define "limited" varies by cancer type and study; the term does not by itself predict outcome.

Oligonucleotide

A short piece of DNA or RNA made in the laboratory or found in cells. It can be used to detect genetic material, block or change gene messages, or

help read and study genes.

Oligopeptide

A short chain of amino acids, usually containing only a few to about 20 building blocks. Oligopeptides can act as hormones, signaling molecules, antimicrobial substances, or parts of larger proteins.

Oligosaccharide

A short chain of sugar molecules joined together. Oligosaccharides form parts of cell-surface molecules, affect how cells recognize one another, and occur naturally in foods where some are used by gut bacteria.

Oligospermia

A lower-than-expected sperm concentration in semen. It can reduce fertility and may result from hormone problems, infections, medicines, heat, toxins, varicoceles, genetic conditions, or problems with sperm production.

Oliguria

Abnormally low urine output. In adults, it is often defined as less than 0.5 mL per kilogram of body weight per hour; thresholds vary by age and clinical setting. Causes include dehydration, reduced blood flow, urinary blockage, kidney disease, or medicines, and it can be a sign of acute kidney injury.

Olivary

Relating to the olive-shaped inferior olivary nucleus of the medulla or to an olive-like structure.

Olivary Nucleus

The olivary nucleus is a brainstem structure that sends timing and motor-learning signals to the cerebellum through climbing fibers.

Olive Pontocerebellar Atrophy

A group of progressive brain disorders that damage areas controlling balance and coordination. They may cause worsening unsteadiness, clumsy movements, slurred speech, stiffness, or other neurologic problems.

Olivopontocerebellar Atrophy

A descriptive term for degeneration affecting the inferior olives, pons, and cerebellum, usually associated with progressive incoordination. It has been used for several inherited and sporadic neurologic disorders rather than one distinct disease.

Ollier Disease

A rare, non-hereditary skeletal dysplasia characterized by multiple benign cartilaginous enchondromas developing predominantly in the metaphyses and diaphyses of long bones with marked asymmetrical skeletal involvement and significant risk of malignant chondrosarcoma transformation.

Alternate Names:
Multiple Enchondromatosis; Dyschondroplasia

Ollier's Disease

A nonhereditary skeletal disorder with multiple enchondromas, causing deformity, limb-length discrepancy, and an increased risk of malignancy.

Olmesartan Medoxomil

An oral prodrug converted to olmesartan, an angiotensin II receptor blocker used to treat high blood pressure.

Olopatadine Hydrochloride

Olopatadine hydrochloride is an antihistamine used in eye drops or nasal spray to treat allergic conjunctivitis or rhinitis.

OLP

Abbreviation; see *Oral Lichen Planus*.

Olsenella

Olsenella is a genus of anaerobic bacteria found mainly in the mouth and digestive tract; human infection is uncommon.

Olsenella Uli

An anaerobic gram-positive bacterium found in the mouth and associated with periodontal disease; invasive infection is rare.

Omacetaxine Mepesuccinate

Omacetaxine mepesuccinate is a protein-synthesis inhibitor used for selected chronic myeloid leukemia resistant or intolerant to tyrosine-kinase inhibitors.

Omalizumab

Omalizumab is a monoclonal antibody that binds circulating IgE and reduces allergic inflammation; it is used for selected allergic asthma, chronic urticaria, nasal polyps, and food allergy, with rare anaphylaxis.

Omasum

The omasum is the third compartment of a ruminant stomach, absorbing water and small particles before contents reach the abomasum.

Omega-3

A family of polyunsaturated fats found in fish, flaxseed, walnuts, and some supplements, supporting heart and brain health.

Omega-3 Fatty Acid

A polyunsaturated fatty acid characterized by a double bond three carbons from the methyl terminal end, notably eicosapentaenoic acid (EPA) and docosahexaenoic acid (DHA). Contributes to cardiovascular, neurological, and anti-inflammatory functions.

Omega-3 Fatty Acids

Plural form; see *Omega-3 Fatty Acid*.

Omega-6

A family of essential polyunsaturated fats, found in vegetable oils, nuts, seeds, and many prepared foods. The body uses them for cell membranes and signaling. Linoleic acid is the main dietary form; replacing saturated fats with unsaturated fats generally supports heart health.

Omega-6 Fatty Acids

Essential polyunsaturated fats found in plant oils, nuts, seeds, and many prepared foods. The body needs them for cell membranes and signaling, but overall health depends on balanced intake with other fats.

Alternate Names:
n-6 Fatty Acids; Omega-6 Polyunsaturated Fatty Acids

Omega-N-Methylarginine

Omega-N-methylarginine is a methylated arginine compound that can inhibit nitric-oxide synthase and affect vascular signaling.

Omega Sign

A descriptive term for a furrowed forehead that resembles the Greek letter omega. It has been reported in severe depression but is not specific and cannot establish a diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Veraguth's Fold; Depressive Facial Omega

Omenn Syndrome

A severe inherited immune deficiency that usually begins in infancy. Babies may develop widespread red, peeling skin, swollen lymph nodes, enlarged liver or spleen, diarrhea, poor growth, and repeated serious infections.

Omental Caking

Thickening and nodular change in the greater omentum, often caused by cancer spread within the abdomen. Infection and inflammation can also cause a similar appearance; imaging or surgery may identify it, but it is not a diagnosis by itself.

Alternate Names:
Omental Cake

Omentectomy

Removal of part or all of the greater omentum, commonly performed during staging and cytoreduction for ovarian and other intra-abdominal cancers.

Omentum

A fold of fatty tissue inside the abdomen that hangs from the stomach and partly covers the intestines. It contains blood vessels and immune cells and can help limit the spread of infection or inflammation.

Omeprazole

Omeprazole is a proton-pump inhibitor that irreversibly suppresses gastric H+/K+-ATPase; it treats reflux and peptic-ulcer disease and supports Helicobacter pylori eradication, while prolonged use may affect magnesium, B12, bone, and infection risk.

Ommaya Reservoir

A surgically implanted reservoir connected to a catheter in a brain ventricle, used to sample cerebrospinal fluid or deliver selected medicines.

Omphalitis

Infection of a newborn's umbilical stump, usually during the first weeks of life. Redness spreading onto the skin, swelling, pus, bad smell, fever, poor feeding, or unusual sleepiness may occur, and infection can spread rapidly.

Omphalocele

A birth defect in which abdominal organs protrude through an opening at the navel into a protective sac. Other chromosome or organ abnormalities may also occur.

Omphalocele Repair

Treatment to place an infant's abdominal organs back inside the abdomen and close the opening in the abdominal wall. Repair may be immediate or staged according to the size of the defect and the baby's breathing and circulation.

Onchocerca Volvulus

A roundworm parasite that causes river blindness. It spreads to people through repeated bites from infected blackflies, which breed near fast-flowing rivers. Adult worms live in lumps under the skin; their young can move through the skin and eyes and may cause itching, skin changes, or vision loss.

Onchocerciasis

A parasitic infection caused by Onchocerca volvulus and spread by infected blackflies. It can cause intensely itchy skin, nodules, skin changes, and eye inflammation that may lead to permanent visual impairment or blindness.

Oncocytic Neoplasm

A growth made of cells containing unusually many energy-producing structures, giving them a granular appearance under a microscope. It may be noncancerous or cancerous, depending on the organ and the tumor's other features.

Oncocytoma

A usually noncancerous tumor made of cells containing many energy-producing structures. It most often develops in the kidney but can occur in other organs and may resemble cancer on imaging or tissue examination.

Oncogene

A gene that can make cells grow or survive without normal control when it is changed, overactive, or present in too many copies. Oncogene changes can contribute to the development and progression of cancer.

Oncogenic

Capable of causing or promoting cancer. An oncogenic change, virus, gene, or chemical can increase abnormal cell growth or reduce normal control of cell division.

Oncogenicity

The ability of a substance, infection, genetic change, or other factor to contribute to the development of cancer.

Oncogenic Osteomalacia

Osteomalacia caused by excess fibroblast growth factor 23 (FGF23), usually produced by a phosphaturic mesenchymal tumor. FGF23 causes the kidneys to waste phosphate and lowers active vitamin D, impairing bone mineralization; the tumors are usually benign but can rarely be malignant.

Alternate Names:
Tumor-Induced Osteomalacia; TIO

Oncogenic Virus

A virus capable of contributing to cancer by altering cell growth, suppressing tumor defenses, or integrating or maintaining oncogenic genetic material.

Oncologic Emergency

A cancer-related problem that can quickly threaten life, organ function, or the nervous system. Examples include spinal-cord pressure, blocked major chest veins, dangerously high calcium, tumor breakdown, airway blockage, and infection during low white-cell counts.

Oncologist

A doctor who specializes in cancer care. Medical oncologists use medicines, radiation oncologists use radiation, and surgical oncologists operate; many people receive care from more than one type of oncologist.

Oncology

The branch of medicine focused on cancer diagnosis, staging, treatment, and follow-up. It includes medical, radiation, and surgical oncology and coordinates care across specialties for malignant disease and its effects. Supportive and palliative care may also be part of oncology.

Oncology Nursing

Oncology nursing provides cancer-related assessment, treatment support, symptom control, education, coordination, survivorship, and end-of-life care.

Oncology Nutrition

Nutritional care for people with cancer, addressing intake, symptoms, treatment effects, weight, muscle mass, and personal goals.

Alternate Names:
Cancer Nutrition Support; Oncology Nutrition

Oncology PET

A positron-emission tomography scan, often combined with CT, that uses a small radioactive tracer to show active cancer in the body. It may help assess spread, treatment response, or recurrence, but inflammation can also appear active.

Oncology Rehabilitation

Healthcare that helps people prevent or manage cancer-related problems before, during, or after treatment. It may address fatigue, pain, weakness, nerve symptoms, swelling, movement, nutrition, work, daily activities, and emotional wellbeing.

Oncolytic Virotherapy

Oncolytic virotherapy uses modified viruses that preferentially infect and destroy cancer cells and may stimulate an immune response against the tumor.

Oncolytic Virus

A genetically modified or naturally occurring virus that selectively replicates in and lyses cancer cells while stimulating antitumor immune responses.

Oncolytic Viruses

Plural form; see *Oncolytic Virus*.

Oncoprotein

A protein that promotes abnormal cell growth or survival and can contribute to cancer. It may result from a cancer-causing gene, a mutation, a chromosome change, or infection with certain viruses.

Oncosis

A form of cell injury in which cells swell and may die, usually because severe lack of oxygen or another injury disrupts energy production and the movement of salt and water across the cell membrane.

Oncotic Pressure

The pulling force created by proteins in the blood, mainly albumin, that helps keep fluid inside blood vessels. When blood protein is low, fluid may leak into tissues and cause swelling.

Oncotoxic

Harmful to cancer cells or relating to substances that damage tumors. An oncotoxic treatment may

also injure healthy cells, with effects depending on the substance, dose, and exposure.

Ondansetron

Ondansetron is a selective 5-HT3-receptor antagonist used to prevent nausea and vomiting after chemotherapy, radiotherapy, surgery, or other triggers; constipation, headache, and QT prolongation can occur.

Ondansetron Hydrochloride

Alternate form; see *Ondansetron*.

Ondine Curse

An older eponym for congenital central hypoventilation syndrome, a disorder in which automatic breathing is inadequate, especially during sleep. Most congenital cases are associated with changes in the *PHOX2B* gene.

Alternate Names:
Congenital Central Hypoventilation Syndrome; CCHS

Ondine'S Curse

Alternate spelling; see *Ondine Curse*.

One-Hour Glucose Challenge Test

A screening test for gestational diabetes, often done at 24–28 weeks as part of a two-step testing approach. After drinking a measured glucose solution, blood sugar is checked one hour later. A high result is not a diagnosis and usually leads to a longer test.

Oneirophrenia

A dreamlike state with confusion or impaired reality testing; the term is uncommon and does not represent a specific modern psychiatric diagnosis.

Onset

Onset is the time or manner in which a symptom, disease, or physiologic change begins, such as sudden, gradual, acute, or insidious onset.

Onychia

Inflammation or infection of the nail or nail-producing tissue. It can cause redness, swelling, pain, pus, or changes in nail growth and may result from bacteria, fungi, injury, or skin disease. Treatment depends on the cause.

Onychauxis

Thickening of the nail plate without the marked claw-like curve of onychogryphosis. It may affect one or more nails and can follow repeated injury, fungal infection, psoriasis, or other nail disease. The thickened nail may become difficult to trim or uncomfortable in footwear.

Onychodystrophy

An abnormal change in the shape, color, thickness, texture, or growth of a nail. It is a finding rather than one specific disease and can result from infection, injury, skin disease, medicines, or illness elsewhere in the body. See also *Nail Abnormalities*.

Onychocryptosis

Onychocryptosis is an ingrown nail, usually at the great toe, in which the nail edge penetrates surrounding skin and causes pain or inflammation.

Onychogryphosis

Severe thickening and overgrowth of a nail, which becomes curved and may resemble a claw. It is more common in older adults and can follow injury, fungal infection, poor circulation, or difficulty caring for the feet; it may cause pain in shoes.

Onycholysis

Separation of the nail plate from the underlying nail bed, beginning distally or laterally. Causes include trauma, psoriasis, fungal infection, thyroid disease, medications, and chemical exposure.

Onychomadesis

Onychomadesis is proximal separation and shedding of a nail caused by temporary arrest of nail-matrix growth, often after infection, systemic illness, trauma, or medication exposure.

Onychomatricoma

A rare, usually benign tumor that begins in the nail matrix, the area that makes the nail plate. It may cause a thickened, yellow nail with lengthwise ridges or bleeding beneath the nail. Its appearance can resemble a fungal infection or other nail growth.

Onychomycosis

A fungal infection of a nail, more common in toenails than fingernails. The nail may become thick, yellow or white, brittle, crumbly, or separated from the skin. A sample may be tested before prolonged antifungal treatment because other nail diseases look similar.

Onychomycosis (Fungal Nail Infection)

Alternate name; see *Onychomycosis*.

Onychopapilloma

A rare, usually benign growth arising from the nail unit. It often causes a lengthwise red or white band in one nail, with thickened skin or a small mass beneath the nail's free edge. It most often affects a fingernail and can resemble other nail disorders.

Onychophagia (Nail Biting)

Alternate name; see *Nail-Biting*.

Onychorrhexis

Lengthwise ridges or splits in the nail plate. The nails may also be brittle and break easily. This change can occur with aging, repeated wetting and drying, nail injury, or skin and general health conditions; it is a sign rather than a single disease.

Onychoschizia

Splitting of the nail plate into thin layers at its free edge. It often affects brittle nails and may follow repeated wetting and drying, chemical exposure, or minor injury. It differs from onychorrhexis, which describes lengthwise ridges or splits.

Onychotillomania

Repeated picking, pulling, or tearing at the nails, causing self-inflicted injury to the nail plate or nearby tissue. It may lead to nail thinning, grooves, discoloration, loss of the nail, or infection. It is distinct from onychophagia, or nail biting.

Oocyte

An immature female reproductive cell in the ovary. Oocytes begin developing before birth and remain paused until they resume maturation during menstrual cycles after puberty. Usually one is released at ovulation; if fertilized, it completes its final maturation and forms an ovum.

Oocyte Cryopreservation

Freezing unfertilized eggs for possible use in future pregnancy. Hormone medicines stimulate the ovaries, and the eggs are collected through the vagina with a needle before being rapidly frozen. Eggs may be stored before cancer treatment or for other fertility-preservation reasons, but freezing does not guarantee a future pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Egg Freezing

Oocyte Retrieval

A procedure used in assisted reproduction to collect mature eggs from the ovaries. After hormone stimulation, a clinician guides a thin needle through the vagina using ultrasound and gently draws fluid containing the eggs into a container for laboratory fertilization.

Alternate Names:
OPU; Egg Retrieval; Follicular Aspiration

Oocytes

Alternate plural; see *Oocyte*.

Oogenesis

The formation and maturation of egg cells, or ova, in the ovaries. It begins before birth and continues through the reproductive years, with changes during each menstrual cycle.

Oogonium

An oogonium is an early female germ cell that proliferates during embryonic development and gives

rise to primary oocytes.

Oophorectomy

Surgery to remove one or both ovaries. It may treat cancer, a cyst, infection, torsion, or reduce inherited cancer risk; removing both ovaries before natural menopause causes an immediate fall in ovarian hormones.

Oophoritis

Inflammation of an ovary, usually associated with pelvic infection or, less commonly, autoimmune disease. It may cause lower abdominal or pelvic pain, fever, abnormal discharge, or menstrual changes; severe pain can occur with ovarian torsion or abscess.

Ooplasm

Ooplasm is the cytoplasm of an egg cell, containing organelles, nutrients, and molecular factors that support fertilization and early embryo development.

Opacity

Clouding of a normally clear part of the eye, such as the cornea, lens, or fluid inside the eye. It can blur vision and may result from injury, infection, inflammation, swelling, or age-related change.

Open Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm Repair

Open surgery to repair a widened, weakened area of the abdominal aorta. The surgeon reaches the aorta through the abdomen and replaces the damaged section with a strong artificial tube.

Alternate Names:
Open AAA Repair; Surgical AAA Repair

Open-Angle Glaucoma

A type of glaucoma in which the eye's drainage angle remains open, but fluid drains too slowly. Pressure may rise and damage the optic nerve, causing gradual, permanent vision loss, often without early symptoms.

Open Aortic Valve Surgery

Surgery to repair or replace a diseased aortic valve through an incision in the chest. It often uses cardiopulmonary bypass; the specific operation depends on the valve disease and may involve valve repair or replacement.

Alternate Names:
Open Aortic Valve Operation

Open Bite

An open bite is a malocclusion in which upper and lower teeth do not meet in part of the mouth when the jaws are closed.

Open-Book Fracture

A severe pelvic injury in which the front or back pelvic joints separate, making the pelvis widen like an open book. It usually follows major trauma and can cause life-threatening internal bleeding or organ injury.

Open Esophagectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the esophagus through thoracic and/or abdominal incisions, rather than through a minimally invasive approach. It may be performed for esophageal cancer or selected noncancerous disease; reconstruction commonly uses the stomach or another segment of bowel.

Alternate Names:
Open Esophageal Resection

Open Fracture

A fracture associated with a wound that communicates between the fracture site and the external environment. It carries increased risks of infection and tissue damage.

Open Fractures

Alternate plural; see *Open Fracture*.

Open Gallbladder Removal

Surgery to remove the gallbladder through one larger abdominal incision. It may be needed when keyhole surgery is unsafe or cannot be completed; bleeding, infection, bile leakage, and injury to nearby ducts or organs are possible.

Open-Heart Surgery

Surgery in which the chest is opened to repair or treat the heart or its major blood vessels. Some operations use a heart–lung machine while the heart is temporarily stopped; risks depend on the operation and the person's health.

Opening Snap

A sharp sound heard soon after the heart starts to relax, caused by a stiff mitral valve opening. It suggests mitral valve narrowing and is considered with other examination findings.

Alternate Names:
Mitral Opening Snap; OS Sound

Open Lung Biopsy

An open lung biopsy removes a small piece of lung through a surgical chest incision for microscopic diagnosis when less invasive tests are insufficient.

Open Mitral Valve Surgery

Surgery to repair or replace the mitral valve through an incision in the chest. It often uses a heart-lung machine; the approach depends on the valve problem and the person's health.

Open Pleural Biopsy

An open pleural biopsy removes a sample of the lining around the lung through surgery to investigate cancer, infection, or unexplained pleural disease.

Open Prostatectomy

Surgery through an abdominal incision to remove the part of an enlarged prostate that blocks urine flow. It can improve severe urinary obstruction but may cause bleeding, infection, urine leakage, or changes in sexual and urinary function.

Open Reduction And Internal Fixation

Surgery to expose a broken bone, put the pieces back into position, and hold them with plates, screws, wires, or rods. It is used when a cast or other nonsurgical treatment cannot provide safe alignment or stability.

Alternate Names:
ORIF

Open Surgery

Surgery performed through a relatively large incision that allows the surgeon to see and reach the affected area directly. It is used when a larger working space is needed, although recovery may be longer than after some keyhole procedures.

Open Surgical Wound Care

Care of a surgical wound left partly or completely open to drain or heal gradually, usually with dressings and scheduled assessment for infection, bleeding, and healthy tissue growth.

Operable

Able to be treated with surgery because the disease can be safely reached or removed.

Operant Conditioning

Learning in which the likelihood of a behavior changes because of its consequences, such as reinforcement or punishment.

Operating Room

An operating room is a controlled sterile or semi-sterile clinical area equipped for surgical procedures, anesthesia, monitoring, and recovery support.

Operating Tables

Adjustable tables designed to support and position patients during surgery or other procedures while allowing access and maintaining safety.

Operation

A planned surgical procedure used to diagnose, repair, remove, replace, or improve part of the body. It may be performed through an incision or with instruments inserted through small openings, depending on the condition and goal.

Operative Dentistry

The branch of dentistry that repairs teeth damaged by decay, fractures, wear, or developmental defects. Treatment may include fillings, bonding, reshap-

ing, and other procedures that restore appearance, strength, and function.

Operative Vaginal Delivery

Vaginal birth assisted with a vacuum cup or forceps when the baby's position is suitable and birth needs to be completed promptly. Reasons may include prolonged pushing or concern about the baby's condition; tears, bleeding, or injury to the baby can occur.

Operator

A person who performs a procedure or operates equipment; in healthcare, training and authorization are essential.

Operculum

A lid, covering, or flap-like structure; in anatomy it may cover an opening or cortical region.

Ophthalmia

Inflammation of the eye, especially the conjunctiva or other surface tissues. It may cause redness, discharge, pain, light sensitivity, or blurred vision and can result from infection, allergy, injury, or inflammation.

Ophthalmia Neonatorum

Inflammation or infection of a newborn baby's eye during the first weeks of life. It may be caused by bacteria passed during birth, other infections, or chemical irritation; redness, swelling, or pus may occur and can threaten the cornea and vision.

Ophthalmic

Relating to the eye. An ophthalmic medicine, drop, ointment, or device is formulated or designed for use on or around the eye; contamination can cause infection or injury.

Ophthalmic Emergency

An eye problem that can rapidly cause permanent vision loss or serious injury. Examples include sudden vision loss, retinal detachment, severe eye infection, chemical exposure, a penetrating injury, or rapidly painful high eye pressure.

Ophthalmic Pathology

The medical subspecialty that examines tissue specimens from the eye and ocular adnexa, including the eyelids, conjunctiva, and orbit. Microscopic evaluation helps diagnose tumors, inflammation, infection, degenerative disease, and developmental disorders of these structures.

Ophthalmic Solution

A sterile liquid medicine made for application to the eye. Contamination or sharing can introduce microorganisms and cause eye infection.

Ophthalmitis

Inflammation of the eye caused by infection, immune disease, injury, or surgery. It may cause redness, pain, light sensitivity, discharge, or blurred vision; severe forms can threaten vision.

Ophthalmologist

A medical doctor trained to diagnose and treat eye disease and vision problems. Ophthalmologists can prescribe medicines and glasses, perform eye procedures and surgery, and manage conditions affecting the eye, optic nerve, and visual system.

Ophthalmology

The medical and surgical specialty concerned with the eyes and visual system. Ophthalmologists diagnose and treat eye diseases, assess visual function and refractive errors, prescribe optical correction, and perform ocular procedures and surgery. The field also includes disorders of the optic nerves and visual pathways.

Ophthalmomyiasis

Infestation of the eye by fly larvae. Larvae may remain on the eye surface or enter deeper tissues, causing intense irritation, pain, inflammation, or vision loss; treatment involves removal of the larvae and management of tissue injury.

Ophthalmoplegia

Weakness or paralysis of the muscles that move the eyes, causing restricted eye movement, double vision, or abnormal eye alignment. It may result from disorders of the eye muscles, neuromuscular junction, cranial nerves, or brain pathways; causes include myasthenia gravis, thyroid eye disease, stroke, trauma, and mitochondrial disorders.

Ophthalmoscope

A lighted instrument used to examine the back and internal structures of the eye, including the retina, macula, optic nerve, and retinal blood vessels. Direct ophthalmoscopes provide a magnified view through the pupil, while indirect ophthalmoscopes use a separate light and lens to provide a wider view. Findings may relate to diabetes, high blood pressure, glaucoma, infection, inflammation, or other eye and nervous-system disorders.

Ophthalmoscopy

Examination of the inside of the eye with a lighted instrument. It allows a clinician to inspect the retina, optic nerve, and blood vessels for changes caused by diabetes, high blood pressure, glaucoma, inflammation, or other disease.

Opiate

A naturally occurring opioid alkaloid from the opium poppy, such as morphine or codeine. Opiates can relieve pain but may cause sleepiness, constipation, dependence, and dangerously slow breathing.

Opiate Alkaloid

An opiate alkaloid is a naturally occurring alkaloid from the opium poppy, such as morphine or codeine, with opioid analgesic and dependence potential.

Opiate And Opioid Withdrawal

Opioid withdrawal is a predictable syndrome after reducing or stopping opioid exposure, producing anxiety, sweating, muscle aches, diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, and autonomic symptoms.

Opiate Assay

A laboratory test that detects or measures opiates or their breakdown products in urine, blood, saliva, or another specimen. Results may support clinical care or toxicology testing, but some synthetic opioids require separate tests.

Opiate Overdose

A life-threatening amount of an opioid medicine or drug that slows brain and breathing activity. Extreme sleepiness, pinpoint pupils, slow or absent breathing, blue lips, or inability to wake may occur. Naloxone can sometimes restore breathing.

Opiate Overdose Triad

The common combination of extreme sleepiness or unconsciousness, very slow or stopped breathing, and very small pupils after an opioid overdose. Not every person has all three signs. Naloxone may restore breathing.

Opioid

A natural, semi-synthetic, or synthetic substance that binds to opioid receptors (mu, delta, kappa) to produce analgesia, sedation, euphoria, respiratory depression, and constipation.

Opioid Addiction

Alternate name; see *Opioid Use Disorder*.

Opioid Agonist Treatment

Treatment for opioid use disorder using a prescribed medicine, usually methadone or buprenorphine, that activates opioid receptors in a controlled way. It reduces withdrawal and cravings, lowers illicit opioid use and overdose risk, and works best with ongoing medical support.

Opioid Analgesic Medications

Medicines that act on opioid receptors to reduce pain. They may be used for selected acute or cancer-related pain and can cause sedation, constipation, physical dependence, tolerance, and life-threatening respiratory depression.

Alternate Names:
Opioid Analgesics; Narcotic Analgesics

Opioid Dependence

A state in which the body adapts to repeated opioid exposure and withdrawal symptoms occur when the medicine or drug is reduced or stopped. Physical dependence can occur during appropriate pain treatment and is different from opioid use disorder, which involves problematic use and loss of control.

Opioid Intoxication

Opioid intoxication can cause euphoria, drowsiness, slowed breathing, pinpoint pupils, impaired coordination, coma, and death.

Opioid Overdose

Poisoning from an excessive amount of an opioid, commonly causing reduced consciousness and dangerously slow or absent breathing. Small pupils may occur but are not always present; untreated respiratory depression can lead to brain injury or death.

Opioid Poisoning

Alternate name; see *Opioid Toxicity*.

Opioid Receptor

A cell-surface protein activated or blocked by opioids and naturally produced endorphins. Mu, kappa, and delta receptors influence pain, breathing, mood, bowel movement, and reward; excessive mu-receptor activation can suppress breathing.

Opioid Reversal

Emergency treatment of opioid toxicity with naloxone, a competitive opioid-receptor antagonist. It is titrated to restore adequate breathing, with repeated doses or monitoring sometimes needed because its effect may wear off before the opioid.

Opioids

Plural form; see *Opioid*.

Opioid Toxicity

Toxic effects of opioid agonists, classically respiratory depression, central nervous system depression, and miosis. Management prioritizes ventilation and airway support; naloxone is titrated to restore adequate breathing while recognizing the risk of recurrent toxicity and withdrawal.

Opioid Toxidrome

A poisoning pattern caused by opioid excess, characterized by respiratory depression, reduced consciousness, and small pupils; naloxone and ventilatory support may be required.

Opioid Use Disorder

A chronic medical condition characterized by a problematic pattern of opioid use that leads to significant physical, emotional, or social impairment and distress. It involves a compulsive urge or craving to use prescription pain relievers or illicit opioids, difficulty controlling the amount or frequency of use, and persistent use despite awareness of harmful consequences.

Alternate Names:
OUD

Opioid Withdrawal

A characteristic group of symptoms occurring after abrupt reduction or cessation of prolonged opioid use, including anxiety, muscle aches, sweating, abdominal cramps, diarrhea, nausea, and insomnia.

Opisthorchis Felineus

A liver fluke acquired by eating raw or undercooked freshwater fish; chronic infection can cause bile-duct inflammation and increase cholangiocarcinoma risk.

Opisthotonos

Severe backward arching of the head, neck, and spine caused by sustained muscle spasm. It can occur with tetanus, strychnine poisoning, severe brain or meningeal disease, and some acute drug reactions.

Opisthotonus

Alternate spelling; see *Opisthotonos*.

Opium

The dried latex of Papaver somniferum containing

opioid alkaloids; it can cause dependence and respiratory depression.

Oppenheim Sign

A pathological neurological reflex elicited by firmly stroking down the anterior medial aspect of the tibia with the examiner's thumb and knuckles, provoking extension (dorsiflexion) of the great toe and fanning of the other toes in corticospinal upper motor neuron dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Oppenheim Reflex; Oppenheim's Sign

Opponens

A muscle that moves a body part toward an opposing surface, especially the thumb across the palm.

Opportunistic Infection

An infection that causes illness mainly when the immune system is weakened or a normal protective barrier is damaged. Causes may include cancer treatment, HIV, transplantation, severe illness, or prolonged use of immune-suppressing medicines.

Opportunistic Pathogen

A microorganism that is more likely to cause illness when immune defenses are weakened or a body barrier is damaged. For example, *Pneumocystis jirovecii* can cause severe pneumonia in people with advanced HIV.

Opposition

Movement of the thumb across the palm so it can touch the fingertips. It is important for grasping and depends on several small movements at the joint where the thumb meets the wrist.

Oppositional Defiant Disorder

A childhood or adolescent disorder involving a persistent pattern, lasting at least six months, of angry or irritable mood, argumentative or defiant behavior, or vindictiveness toward an authority figure or other person. The pattern causes clinically significant distress or impairment and is not limited to conflicts with siblings.

Opsoclonus

Rapid, involuntary, back-and-forth eye movements in many directions without pauses. It may occur with muscle jerks and poor coordination, sometimes because of an immune reaction, infection, medicine, or an underlying tumor.

Opsoclonus-Myoclonus-Ataxia Syndrome

A rare neurologic syndrome combining rapid, involuntary eye movements in many directions with muscle jerks and poor coordination. In children it may be associated with neuroblastoma or an immune-mediated process.

Alternate Names:
Dancing Eye-Dancing Feet Syndrome; Kinsbourne Syndrome; OMS

Opsoclonus-Myoclonus Syndrome

A rare neurologic disorder causing rapid, involuntary eye movements, muscle jerks, poor coordination, and sometimes behavioral or cognitive changes. In children it may be associated with neuroblastoma or an immune reaction.

Opsonin

An immune protein that coats a germ and marks it for destruction. Antibodies and complement proteins can act as opsonins by helping infection-fighting cells recognize and engulf the germ.

Opsonization

The coating of a germ or other particle with immune proteins so that infection-fighting cells can recognize, capture, and destroy it more easily. Antibodies and complement proteins commonly perform this function.

Optical Aids

Eyeglasses correct focusing errors, sunglasses reduce glare and ultraviolet exposure, and magnifiers enlarge nearby targets. Correct prescription, fit, lens protection, and the underlying eye condition determine the appropriate aid.

Optical Coherence Tomography

A painless scan that uses reflected light to create detailed cross-sectional pictures of the retina and other eye structures. It helps detect and monitor glaucoma, macular disease, swelling, and other changes without touching the eye.

Optical Coherence Tomography Angiography

A scan that uses optical coherence tomography to show blood flow in small vessels of the retina and the layer beneath it, without injecting a dye.

Optical Illusion

A visual perception in which an object, image, or movement appears different from its physical properties. Illusions are common, but new or persistent visual distortions may occur with eye, brain, medicine, or migraine-related disorders.

Optical Rotation

The turning of plane-polarized light as it passes through a substance whose molecules have a particular three-dimensional arrangement. Measuring it can help identify or assess the concentration of some chemicals and medicines.

Optic Atrophy

Damage and loss of optic-nerve fibers, causing permanent reduction in vision, color vision, or part of the visual field. Causes include glaucoma, poor blood supply, inflammation, pressure, injury, toxins, and inherited disorders; treatment targets the cause when possible.

Optic Chiasm

An X-shaped junction beneath the brain where some fibers from the optic nerves cross. Damage can cause characteristic loss of parts of the visual field, depending on the location and cause.

Optic Chiasma

Alternate spelling; see *Optic Chiasm*.

Optic Disc

The small area at the back of the eye where the optic nerve and blood vessels pass through the retina. It has no light-sensing cells, so it creates the eye's normal blind spot.

Optic Disc Drusen

Clusters of protein-like material within the optic nerve head that often calcify with age. They can make the optic disc look elevated, mimicking papilledema, and may be associated with visual-field defects.

Alternate Names:
Optic Nerve Head Drusen; Pseudopapilledema Drusen

Optic Disc Edema

Swelling of the optic nerve head where the nerve enters the eye. Causes include raised intracranial pressure, inflammation, impaired blood supply, and local eye or optic-nerve disease. Papilledema is optic-disc edema specifically caused by raised intracranial pressure.

Optic Disc Swelling

Enlargement or elevation of the optic nerve head where it enters the eye. Causes range from raised pressure inside the skull to inflammation, ischemia, or local eye disease; sudden vision changes can indicate serious ocular or neurologic disease.

Optic Disk

The point where the optic nerve leaves the retina; it has no photoreceptors and forms the blind spot.

Optic Embolism

An embolus in the retinal arterial circulation, more precisely termed a retinal artery embolus. It may temporarily or persistently obstruct blood flow and cause focal retinal ischemia or visual loss; sustained blockage is termed retinal artery occlusion.

Optic Glioma

A usually slow-growing tumor of the optic nerve or the visual pathway leading to the brain, most often

in children. It may cause reduced vision, loss of part of the visual field, a bulging eye, or abnormal eye movements and is associated with neurofibromatosis type 1.

Alternate Names:
Optic Pathway Glioma; Optic Nerve Glioma

Optician

A technician who fits and dispenses eyeglasses or contact lenses.

Optic Nerve

The nerve that carries visual signals from each eye to the brain. Damage can cause reduced vision, loss of color or part of the visual field, and sometimes pain with eye movement.

Optic Nerve Atrophy

Permanent damage and loss of nerve fibers carrying vision from the eye to the brain. It can reduce sharpness, color vision, or part of the visual field and may follow glaucoma, inflammation, poor blood supply, pressure, injury, or toxins.

Optic Nerve Disorder

A disease affecting the optic nerve, which carries visual signals from the eye to the brain; it can cause reduced vision, color loss, or visual-field defects.

Optic Nerve Glioma

Alternate name; see *Optic Glioma*.

Optic Nerve Swelling

Swelling of the optic nerve head where the nerve enters the eye. It may be caused by raised pressure inside the skull, inflammation, reduced blood supply, infection, or other eye or nerve disease; new swelling with headache or vision change can indicate serious disease.

Optic Neuritis

Inflammation or demyelination of the optic nerve, often causing subacute vision loss, impaired color vision, and pain with eye movement. It may be associated with multiple sclerosis or other inflammatory, infectious, or immune-mediated disorders.

Optic Pathway Glioma

Alternate name; see *Optic Glioma*.

Optic Tract

A bundle of nerve fibers carrying visual information from the optic chiasma to brain areas that process sight and control visual reflexes. Damage causes loss of a characteristic part of the visual field.

Optokinetic Nystagmus

Rhythmic eye movements produced when a person views a large moving visual scene, consisting of a slow tracking phase followed by a rapid resetting phase.

Optometrist

A trained eye-care professional who examines vision and many ocular conditions and prescribes optical correction within local scope of practice.

Optometry

The healthcare profession focused on examining vision and the eyes, prescribing glasses or contact lenses, detecting eye disease, and providing treatment or referral within the professional scope allowed by local law.

Oral

Relating to the mouth, or taken through the mouth. Oral medicines are swallowed and absorbed through the digestive tract unless otherwise specified.

Oral Administration

Taking a medicine by mouth so it is absorbed through the digestive tract; absorption can be affected by food, vomiting, interactions, or gastrointestinal disease.

Oral Allergy Syndrome

Also called pollen-food allergy syndrome, it is an IgE-mediated reaction to plant foods that cross-react with pollen allergens, causing itching or tingling of the mouth, lips, or throat. Symptoms most

often follow raw fruits or vegetables; heat-labile allergens may be altered by cooking. Systemic reactions are uncommon but can occur.

Alternate Names:
Pollen-Food Allergy Syndrome

Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery

The surgical specialty concerned with diseases, injuries, and defects of the mouth, jaws, face, and associated hard and soft tissues. Its scope includes corrective jaw procedures and reconstruction after trauma or disease.

Oral Antidiabetic Agents

A broad group of prescription medications taken by mouth to help lower and maintain blood glucose levels in people with type 2 diabetes. Different classes work through various physiological mechanisms, such as increasing the body's responsiveness to insulin, prompting the pancreas to release additional insulin, or helping the kidneys filter excess sugar out of the body through urine.

Oral Appliance Therapy

Treatment using a removable dental appliance during sleep, commonly to advance the mandible or retain the tongue and reduce upper-airway collapse in selected obstructive sleep apnea.

Oral Burn

An injury to the lining of the mouth, tongue, lips, or palate caused by heat, a chemical, or electricity. It may cause pain, redness, peeling, or sores; swelling that affects breathing can be life-threatening.

Alternate Names:
Oral Cavity Burn; Mouth Burn; Thermal Palatal Burn

Oral Cancer

Cancer of the lips or tissues inside the mouth, including the tongue, gums, cheeks, floor of the mouth, and roof of the mouth. Tobacco, alcohol, and chewing areca (betel) nut increase risk. It may cause a lasting sore, lump, red or white patch, pain, or numbness. Human papillomavirus (HPV) is more strongly linked to cancers of the throat behind the mouth.

Oral Candidiasis

A yeast infection of the mouth or throat, often called oral thrush. It may cause white patches, redness, soreness, altered taste, or cracks at the mouth corners. Risk is higher with antibiotics, steroid inhalers, dentures, diabetes, or a weakened immune system.

Alternate Names:
Oral Thrush; Thrush; Oropharyngeal Candidiasis

Oral And Pharyngeal Candidiasis

Alternate name; see *Oral Candidiasis*.

Oral Cavity

The space inside the mouth, extending from the lips to the throat and bounded by the cheeks, palate, tongue, and floor of the mouth. It receives food, begins digestion, and helps with speech, taste, and breathing.

Oral Cavity Cancer

Cancer arising in the lips, tongue, gums, inner cheeks, floor of the mouth, or palate. Tobacco, alcohol, betel quid, and some HPV infections increase risk; persistent sores, lumps, patches, pain, or numbness may occur.

Oral Cholecystogram

An older X-ray test in which swallowed contrast collects in the gallbladder, allowing gallstones and gallbladder function to be assessed. Ultrasound and other imaging methods have largely replaced it.

Oral Contraceptive

A birth-control pill containing progestin alone or progestin combined with estrogen. It mainly prevents ovulation and thickens cervical mucus; it does not protect against sexually transmitted infections.

Oral Contraceptive Pill

An oral hormonal contraceptive, usually a combined estrogen–progestin pill or a progestin-only pill, that prevents ovulation and/or changes cervical mucus and the uterine lining.

Oral Cutaneous Fistulas

Abnormal channels connecting the mouth or an oral structure with the skin surface, often caused by dental infection, salivary-gland disease, trauma, surgery, or inflammatory disease. Persistent drainage or swelling can occur.

Oral-Facial-Digital Syndrome

A group of genetic disorders affecting the mouth, face, fingers, and toes. Features vary and may include oral abnormalities, unusual facial development, shortened or joined digits, and neurologic or kidney problems.

Oral Fibromas and Fibromatoses

Benign fibrous overgrowths in the mouth or jaw region. A solitary oral fibroma is often a firm response to chronic irritation, whereas fibromatoses can infiltrate nearby tissue and recur; persistent lesions may resemble other growths.

Oral Glucose Tolerance Test

A test in which a person drinks a measured sugar solution and has blood sugar checked afterward. It helps assess diabetes, prediabetes, or gestational diabetes when other tests do not give a clear answer.

Oral Hairy Leukoplakia

A painless white, ridged patch, usually on the side of the tongue, caused by Epstein-Barr virus. It occurs most often in people with weakened immunity, including some people with HIV, and usually cannot be wiped away.

Alternate Names:
OHL

Oral Health

Oral health is the condition of the teeth, gums, mouth, jaw, and related functions such as eating, speaking, and swallowing.

Oral Hemangiomas

Benign blood-vessel lesions of the lips, tongue, gums, or other oral tissues that may appear red, blue, or purple and bleed after trauma. Evaluation distinguishes them from vascular malformations and other tumors; treatment depends on symptoms and risk.

Oral Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the mouth, gums, tongue, throat, or nearby tissues, caused by trauma, dental disease, infection, medicines, or a bleeding disorder.

Oral Herpes

Infection of the mouth or lips by the herpes simplex virus, usually type 1. It may cause no symptoms, but can cause painful blisters or sores. Cold sores may return and often begin with tingling or burning.

Alternate Names:
Herpes Simplex Labialis; Cold Sores; Fever Blisters; Oral HSV-1 Infection

Oral Human Papillomavirus Infection

Oral human papillomavirus infection affects the mouth or throat; many infections clear without symptoms, while persistent high-risk types can contribute to some cancers.

Oral Hygiene

Practices that keep the teeth, gums, and other mouth tissues clean and healthy and help limit plaque, tooth decay, and gum disease.

Oral Hypoglycemics Overdose

Toxic effects from taking too much oral diabetes medicine. Some medicines can cause dangerously low blood glucose, leading to sweating, shaking, confusion, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Oral Leukoplakia

A persistent white patch in the mouth that cannot be rubbed off and is not explained by another condition. It is often linked to tobacco, alcohol, or betel-nut use and can sometimes develop into mouth cancer.

Oral Leukoplakia and Erythroplakia Pathology

Histopathologic evaluation of persistent white or red oral mucosal lesions for hyperkeratosis, epithelial

dysplasia, carcinoma in situ, or invasive squamous cell carcinoma. The clinical appearance alone does not determine the diagnosis.

Oral Lichen Planus

A long-lasting condition that can cause lace-like white lines, red patches, or painful sores inside the mouth, often on the cheeks or gums. It may improve and worsen over time, and its appearance can resemble other mouth diseases.

Alternate Names:
OLP; Mucosal Lichen Planus

Oral Medications for Type 2 Diabetes

Oral medicines for type 2 diabetes lower glucose through effects on insulin, liver glucose production, kidney reabsorption, or intestinal absorption; choice depends on health and treatment goals.

Oral Moniliasis

Oral moniliasis is oral candidiasis, a Candida yeast infection causing white plaques, soreness, burning, or altered taste.

Oral Mucosa

The moist lining of the mouth, including the inner lips and cheeks, gums, tongue, and palate. It protects deeper tissues, provides sensation, stays lubricated, and can develop ulcers, infections, inflammation, or tumors.

Oral Mucous Cyst

An oral mucous cyst is a mucus-filled lesion caused by salivary-gland duct injury or blockage, often appearing on the lower lip or floor of the mouth.

Oral Nutritional Supplement

A calorie-, protein-, or micronutrient-containing product consumed by mouth to increase nutrient intake when ordinary food provides insufficient energy or nutrients. Composition and suitability vary with nutritional needs and swallowing ability.

Oral Pathology

The study and diagnosis of diseases affecting the mouth, teeth, jaws, and related tissues. These include tooth decay, infections, cysts, inflammation, developmental changes, and tumors. Examination, imaging, laboratory tests, or a tissue sample may be needed to identify the cause.

Oral Potentially Malignant Disorders

Conditions affecting the mouth lining that carry an increased risk of developing into oral cancer. Examples include leukoplakia, erythroplakia, and some long-lasting inflammatory or inherited disorders; appearance alone cannot determine the risk.

Oral Psoriasis Therapy

Treatment of psoriasis with systemic medicines taken by mouth. Options include conventional drugs such as methotrexate, ciclosporin, and acitretin, and targeted oral medicines such as apremilast or deucravacitinib. This route differs from topical medicines applied to the skin and biologic medicines usually given by injection or infusion.

Oral Pyogenic Granuloma

A rapidly growing, friable vascular overgrowth of the gums or other oral mucosa, often related to irritation, trauma, or pregnancy. It bleeds easily and may recur unless the lesion and its local cause are treated.

Oral Radiology

The use and interpretation of X-rays and other scans of the mouth, teeth, jaws, face, and nearby structures. These images help find decay, infection, fractures, tumors, bone disease, and problems related to treatment planning.

Oral Rehydration Salts

A balanced mixture of glucose and electrolytes dissolved in clean water to replace fluid and salts lost through diarrhea or vomiting.

Oral Rehydration Therapy

Replacement of water and electrolytes by mouth using a balanced glucose-and-salt solution, especially to prevent or treat dehydration from diarrhoea or vomiting.

Alternate Names:
ORT

Oral Route

Administration of a medicine by swallowing it through the mouth for absorption in the digestive tract. Absorption may be altered by food, vomiting, or gastrointestinal disease.

Alternate Names:
PO; Per Os; By Mouth

Oral Sex Practices

Sexual stimulation of the genitals or anus using the mouth. Fellatio means oral stimulation of the penis, cunnilingus of the vulva or clitoris, and analingus of the anus. Some sexually transmitted infections can spread through oral sex.

Alternate Names:
Oral-Genital Stimulation

Oral Spray

A liquid medicine or preparation sprayed into the mouth or throat for local treatment or absorption through oral tissues.

Oral Squamous Cell Carcinoma

The most common type of mouth cancer, arising from the cells lining the lips, tongue, gums, cheeks, or palate. It may present as a persistent sore, lump, red or white patch, bleeding, pain, or numbness.

Oral Submucous Fibrosis

A long-lasting condition in which scar tissue forms inside the mouth, strongly linked to chewing areca (betel) nut or betel quid, a chew made with betel leaf and other ingredients. The mouth may become stiff and hard to open; burning and trouble eating or swallowing may occur. The condition can sometimes become cancerous.

Alternate Names:
OSMF

Oral Surgery

Operations on the mouth, teeth, jaws, or nearby facial tissues. Procedures include tooth removal, dental implants, tissue sampling, cyst removal, repair of injury, and correction of jaw problems.

Oral Thrush

Alternate name; see *Oral Candidiasis*.

Oral Toxicity

Harm to the mouth, throat, or digestive system caused by a swallowed poison, medicine, treatment, or excessive dose. It may cause burning, sores, nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, or rapidly developing organ injury.

Oral Verruciform Xanthoma

A rare, noncancerous growth in the lining of the mouth, often on the gums or hard palate. It may appear as a pink, yellow, or gray raised spot with a rough or warty surface. A biopsy may be needed because it can resemble other oral growths.

Oral Yeast Infection

Alternate name; see *Oral Candidiasis*.

Orange Peel Skin

Skin with a dimpled surface resembling an orange peel, caused by edema or tissue thickening around hair follicles. The appearance may occur with lymphatic obstruction, including in inflammatory breast cancer, but it also has noncancerous causes and is not diagnostic by itself.

Orbicularis

A circular muscle surrounding an opening, such as orbicularis oculi around the eye or orbicularis oris around the mouth.

Orbit

The bony socket that contains and protects the eye, its muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and supporting tissues. Problems in the orbit can cause pain, swelling, double vision, bulging, or impaired eye movement.

Orbital

Relating to the orbit, the bony cavity containing the eye, or to structures within it. Orbital disease

may affect the eye, muscles, nerves, or surrounding tissues.

Orbital Apex Syndrome

A clinical syndrome resulting from compressive, neoplastic, or inflammatory lesions located at the orbital apex involving both the superior orbital fissure and the optic canal, characterized by combined palsies of cranial nerves III, IV, V1, and VI (complete ophthalmoplegia, ptosis, and forehead sensory loss) associated with optic nerve (CN II) atrophy and vision loss.

Alternate Names:
Apex Orbitae Syndrome; Combined Superior Orbital Fissure and Optic Canal Syndrome

Orbital Blowout Fracture

A break in one of the thin bones forming the eye socket, usually after blunt trauma. It can cause swelling, double vision, numbness, or restricted eye movement and may trap an eye muscle or injure nearby structures.

Orbital Cavity

The bony space in the skull that contains and protects the eye, its muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and supporting tissues.

Orbital Cellulitis

A serious infection in the tissues around and behind the eye. It can cause eyelid swelling, fever, pain with eye movement, double vision, or reduced vision and can spread to the brain.

Orbital Contusion

A bruise of the tissues around the eye caused by blunt trauma, often producing swelling, bruising, and tenderness.

Orbital Floor Fracture

A break in the thin bone forming the bottom of the eye socket, usually caused by blunt facial trauma. The floor is formed mainly by the maxilla. The fracture may cause double vision, restricted eye movement, numbness of the cheek or upper lip, or a sunken appearance of the eye; some fractures trap tissues that move the eye.

Alternate Names:
Blowout Fracture of the Orbit; Orbital Floor Blowout

Orbital Fracture

A traumatic fracture involving the bony walls of the eye socket, classically an orbital blowout fracture of the thin inferior or medial wall.

Orbital Fracture Repair

Surgery to restore the structure of a fractured orbital wall or floor. It may involve releasing trapped orbital tissue and supporting the repaired area with an implant or graft.

Orbital Fractures

Plural form; see *Orbital Fracture*.

Orbital Irradiation

Radiation treatment directed at tissues within the eye socket, sometimes used for severe thyroid eye disease.

Orbital Metastasis

Cancer that has spread to the bony socket around the eye from another organ, commonly the breast, lung, or prostate. It may cause bulging of the eye, pain, double vision, restricted movement, or reduced sight.

Orbital Myositis

Inflammation of one or more muscles that move the eye. It can cause pain, eyelid swelling, double vision, and restricted eye movement; treatment depends on the cause.

Orbital Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the eye socket that may arise from the eye, optic nerve, muscles, glands, bone, or other tissues. It can cause bulging, pain, double vision, or vision loss and may be benign or cancerous.

Orbital Pseudotumor

Painful inflammation of tissues around the eye that is not caused by infection or a true tumor. It may cause eyelid swelling, bulging of the eye, double vision, and painful or limited eye movement.

Alternate Names:
Idiopathic Orbital Inflammatory Disease; IOID

Orbital Tumors

Benign or malignant growths arising within or around the eye socket. They may cause a visible mass, proptosis, double vision, pain, impaired eye movements, or vision loss; examination and orbital imaging guide biopsy and treatment.

Orbital Varix

An enlarged, flexible vein in the eye socket. The eye may bulge more when a person bends, coughs, or strains and then return to normal when upright. It can rarely bleed, clot, or press on the optic nerve; imaging helps confirm the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Orbital Phlebectasia; Orbital Venous Varix

Orbit CT Scan

A CT scan of the eye socket that uses X-rays and computer images to show the bones, eye muscles, nerves, blood vessels, and surrounding tissues. It can help assess injury, infection, bleeding, or a growth.

Orchialgia

Pain in one or both testes, which may be acute or chronic. Causes include infection, trauma, varicocele, torsion, referred pain, or neuropathic pain; in some cases no cause is identified. Associated findings vary with the underlying disorder.

Orchidectomy

Alternate spelling; see *Orchiectomy*.

Orchiectomy

Surgical removal of one or both testicles. Radical inguinal orchiectomy is diagnostic and therapeutic for testicular cancer; bilateral orchiectomy is a hormonal therapy for prostate cancer.

Orchitis

Inflammation of one or both testes, usually due to infection. Viral causes include mumps; bacterial orchitis commonly accompanies epididymitis. It can cause testicular pain, swelling, and fever. Bilateral mumps orchitis can impair fertility, although infertility is uncommon.

Order Coleoptera

The insect order containing beetles, characterized by hardened forewings that protect the flying wings; some species affect health as pests or vectors.

Order Spirochaetales

A biological order of spiral-shaped bacteria that includes groups causing syphilis, Lyme disease, relapsing fever, and leptospirosis. Identification of the species determines medical significance and treatment.

Orexin

Orexin, or hypocretin, is a hypothalamic neuropeptide that promotes wakefulness, arousal, appetite, and energy regulation; loss of orexin signaling is strongly associated with narcolepsy type 1.

Orexin Receptor Antagonists

Medicines that block orexin receptors, reducing wakefulness and promoting sleep. Suvorexant and lemborexant are used for insomnia; they can cause next-day drowsiness, have potential for misuse, and may worsen some breathing disorders during sleep.

Orf

A zoonotic skin infection caused by orf virus, a parapoxvirus of sheep and goats. Humans acquire it through contact with infected animals or contaminated fomites; a painful or tender nodular, ulcerating lesion usually develops on the hand or finger and often resolves without treatment.

Organ

A structure composed of two or more different types

of tissues that has a recognizable shape and performs specific functions.

Organelle

A specialized part inside a cell that performs a particular job. Examples include the nucleus, which stores genetic instructions, and mitochondria, which release energy; organelles work together to keep the cell alive.

Alternate Names:
Organelles

Organ Failure

Severe loss of an organ's ability to perform essential functions, such as filtering blood, exchanging oxygen, or pumping blood.

Organic

Relating to living matter or carbon-containing chemistry; in psychiatry, an older term for symptoms caused by a physical brain disorder.

Organic Chemical

A carbon-containing chemical compound, usually also containing hydrogen and sometimes oxygen, nitrogen, sulfur, or other elements. Organic chemicals include medicines, fats, sugars, proteins, solvents, and many toxins.

Organic Disease

An illness caused by a physical change or measurable disturbance in the body, such as infection, inflammation, tissue damage, or abnormal organ function. The term is older and is less useful when symptoms have not yet been explained.

Organic Impurity

An organic impurity is an unintended carbon-containing chemical in a medicine, material, or specimen that may affect safety, quality, or measurement.

Organization Name

The formal name of a group, institution, company, or agency; healthcare records use it to identify the responsible organization.

Organ of Corti

The hearing-sensing structure inside the cochlea of the inner ear. Its hair cells turn sound vibrations into nerve signals that travel to the brain.

Alternate Names:
Spiral Organ

Organogenesis

The embryonic process in which cells from the germ layers differentiate and organize into organs and organ systems. It follows gastrulation and involves coordinated cell signaling, growth, and tissue shaping. Disruption during organogenesis can alter normal organ formation and result in congenital anomalies.

Organophosphate

A class of chemicals that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase. Some are pesticides or nerve agents and can cause cholinergic poisoning.

Organophosphate Poisoning

A serious poisoning caused by pesticides or nerve agents that excessively stimulate nerves and muscles. It may cause sweating, drooling, vomiting, diarrhea, pinpoint pupils, muscle twitching, wheezing, weakness, seizures, or breathing failure.

Organophosphate Toxicity

Poisoning caused by chemicals that inhibit acetylcholinesterase, leading to excess acetylcholine at muscarinic, nicotinic, and central nervous system synapses. Features may include pinpoint pupils, sweating, salivation, vomiting, diarrhea, excessive airway secretions, muscle twitching, weakness, confusion, seizures, and respiratory failure. Delayed neuropathy or persistent neuromuscular weakness may follow severe poisoning.

Organosilicon Compounds

Organosilicon compounds contain silicon bonded to carbon and are used in materials, medicines, devices, and industry; biological effects depend on the specific compound.

Organ System

A group of organs that work together to perform an important body function, such as breathing or digestion.

Organ Transplant

A surgical procedure in which a failing organ (such as kidney, liver, heart, or lung) is replaced with a viable donor organ.

Organ Transplantation

Replacement of a failing organ with a healthy organ from a donor. Transplants can restore function but require careful matching, lifelong monitoring, and medicines to prevent rejection; infection, rejection, and medicine-related harm remain possible.

Organ Transplants

Plural form; see *Organ Transplant*.

Orgasm

The peak of sexual pleasure, usually accompanied by involuntary muscle and body responses that vary among individuals.

Orgasmic Dysfunction

Persistent or recurrent difficulty reaching orgasm, markedly reduced orgasmic intensity, or absent orgasm that causes clinically significant distress. Medical, psychological, medication-related, hormonal, and relationship factors may contribute.

Orgasmic Dysfunction in Women

Alternate name; see *Orgasmic Dysfunction*.

Orientation

Awareness of personal identity, place, time, and situation. Clinicians assess orientation as part of mental-status and neurologic examinations.

Orifice

An opening leading into or out of a body structure, organ, or passage, allowing materials to enter or leave.

Orlistat

A medicine used with a reduced-calorie diet to help with weight loss or weight control. It stops some dietary fat from being absorbed, so oily stools, gas, and urgent bowel movements can occur; it can also reduce absorption of vitamins and some medicines.

Ornithine

A nonessential amino acid and intermediate in the urea cycle that helps convert toxic ammonia into urea.

Ornithine Decarboxylase

An enzyme that converts ornithine to putrescine, an early step in polyamine synthesis involved in cell growth.

Ornithine Transcarbamylase Deficiency

OTC deficiency is an inherited urea-cycle disorder causing ammonia accumulation, vomiting, confusion, seizures, or coma, especially during metabolic stress.

Organizing Pneumonia

A pattern of lung injury in which small plugs of healing tissue block air sacs and nearby airways. It may cause cough, fever, and shortness of breath. It can follow infection or occur with medicines or immune disease; when no cause is found, it is called cryptogenic organizing pneumonia.

Orogastric Tube

A flexible tube passed through the mouth into the stomach. It may deliver nutrition or medicines, remove stomach contents, or decompress the stomach when nasal placement is unsuitable.

Orolabial Herpes Simplex

Alternate name; see *Oral Herpes*.

Oropharyngeal

Oropharyngeal means relating to the mouth and the part of the throat behind it, including structures involved in breathing, swallowing, and speech.

Oropharyngeal Airway

A rigid device placed through the mouth to keep the tongue from blocking the throat in an unconscious person. Insertion in a person with a gag reflex can provoke vomiting, and the device does not prevent vomit from entering the lungs.

Oropharyngeal Cancer

Alternate name; see *Oropharyngeal Carcinoma*.

Oropharyngeal Carcinoma

Cancer arising in the part of the throat behind the mouth, including the tonsils, back of the tongue, soft palate, or throat wall. Tobacco, alcohol, and some HPV infections increase risk; assessment usually includes examination, tissue sampling, and scans.

Oropharyngeal Dysphagia

Difficulty moving food or liquid from the mouth through the throat. It may cause coughing, choking, a wet voice, food coming through the nose, or food entering the airway; persistent dysfunction can cause aspiration and malnutrition.

Oropharyngeal Neoplasm

An oropharyngeal neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the throat behind the mouth, including the tonsils and base of the tongue; it may be benign or malignant.

Oropharynx

The part of the throat behind the mouth, including the tonsils and back of the tongue. It helps move food and liquid toward the esophagus and carries air toward the voice box.

Oropharynx Lesion Biopsy

Sampling of an oropharyngeal lesion, usually through the mouth under local or procedural anesthesia, for histopathologic evaluation of infection, dysplasia, or cancer. It can distinguish benign lesions from malignancy.

Oropouche Fever

An illness caused by Oropouche virus, spread mainly by infected biting midges and sometimes mosquitoes in parts of the Americas. It usually causes sudden fever, severe headache, chills, muscle aches, and joint pain; symptoms may return after improving, and rarely the infection can cause meningitis. Infection during pregnancy has been linked to poor pregnancy outcomes.

Alternate Names:
Oropouche Virus Disease; Oropouche Fever Arbovirus Infection

Orotic Aciduria

An unusually high amount of orotic acid in urine. It may result from a rare inherited disorder affecting blood-cell and DNA building blocks, causing anemia and poor growth, or from a urea-cycle disorder with high ammonia.

Orphan Disease

A rare disease affecting relatively few people; definitions and eligibility for orphan-drug programs vary by jurisdiction.

Orphenadrine

A centrally acting medicine with anticholinergic properties used in some countries for painful muscle spasm; it can cause drowsiness, dry mouth, and confusion.

Orthodontic

Adjectival form; see *Orthodontics*.

Orthodontic Appliance

A device used to move teeth, guide jaw growth, maintain alignment, or correct a bite problem.

Orthodontic Bracket

A bonded or banded attachment that transmits forces from an orthodontic archwire to a tooth. Bracket position and wire sequence guide controlled tooth movement.

Orthodontic Retainer

A removable or fixed appliance used after active orthodontic treatment to maintain tooth position

while periodontal and alveolar tissues remodel. Retention is often needed long term because relapse can occur.

Orthodontics

The dental specialty focused on the diagnosis, prevention, and correction of malpositioned teeth and misaligned jaw relationships.

Orthodontic Treatment

Treatment that uses braces, wires, aligners, or other appliances to move teeth and guide jaw development. It can improve bite, spacing, and cleaning access; planning involves assessment, and retention helps limit relapse.

Orthodontic Wires

Metal or other wires used with braces to apply controlled forces that move teeth or help maintain their position.

Orthodontist

A dentist specially trained to diagnose and treat teeth or jaws that do not align properly. Orthodontists use braces, clear aligners, retainers, and sometimes surgery to improve biting, chewing, appearance, and oral health.

Orthodromic AVRT

The most common form of atrioventricular reentrant tachycardia in Wolff-Parkinson-White syndrome, in which the electrical cardiac impulse conducts antegradely down the normal atrioventricular node and His-Purkinje system (yielding a narrow QRS complex) and retrogradely up the accessory pathway (bundle of Kent) back to the atria.

Orthoebolavirus

A genus of filoviruses that includes Ebola virus, Sudan virus, Bundibugyo virus, and related viruses. Some members cause severe disease in humans, usually transmitted through direct contact with infected blood or body fluids.

Orthognathic Surgery

Corrective surgery to reposition the upper jaw, lower jaw, or both when bone alignment causes problems with biting, chewing, speaking, breathing, or facial development. It is often combined with orthodontic treatment.

Orthohepadnavirus

A group of viruses that includes hepatitis B virus and related viruses infecting mammals. These viruses carry genetic material as DNA and may cause long-lasting liver infection, inflammation, scarring, or cancer.

Orthokeratology

A method that uses specially fitted hard contact lenses worn overnight to temporarily reshape the cornea, the clear front part of the eye. It mainly corrects nearsightedness during the day after the lenses are removed. The effect wears off when lens use stops; overnight wear increases the risk of eye infection.

Alternate Names:
Ortho-K; Corneal Refractive Therapy

Orthokeratosis

Thickening of the outer skin layer with fully mature skin cells. It can be a normal protective response, such as on the soles, or part of conditions causing thick, scaly, or rough skin.

Orthomyxoviridae

A family of viruses that includes influenza A, B, and C. They mainly infect the airways and can cause flu, outbreaks, and sometimes severe pneumonia or other complications.

Orthopaedics

The British spelling of orthopedics, the medical and surgical specialty concerned with the musculoskeletal system.

Orthopaedic Surgery

Surgery for disorders and injuries involving bones, joints, muscles, ligaments, tendons, and related tis-

sues. Procedures may repair fractures, replace joints, correct deformity, stabilize the spine, or relieve pressure on nerves.

Orthopedic Biologics

Biologic materials or products used to support healing of bone, tendon, or other musculoskeletal tissues. Examples include autologous or donor bone graft, bone-marrow-derived products, platelet-rich plasma, and bone morphogenetic proteins; their composition and evidence of benefit vary by product and indication.

Orthopedic Implant

A device placed in or on the body to repair, support, replace, or stabilize a bone or joint. Examples include plates, screws, rods, joint replacements, and artificial ligaments. Possible complications include infection, loosening, breakage, wear, or bone damage.

Orthopedic Infections

Infections involving bones, joints, muscles, or orthopedic implants. Examples include osteomyelitis, septic arthritis, prosthetic-joint infection, and some diabetic foot infections.

Orthopedic Rehabilitation

Treatment that restores movement, strength, daily function, and independence after injury or surgery involving bones, joints, muscles, ligaments, or tendons. It may include exercises, activity training, pain management, and assistive equipment.

Orthopedics

The branch of surgery concerned with the musculoskeletal system, including bones, joints, ligaments, tendons, muscles, and nerves.

Orthopedic Screws

Metal or other screws used to hold broken bones or surgical implants in position while bone heals. Their shape and size are chosen for the bone and purpose. Complications can include loosening, breakage, infection, or injury to nearby structures.

Orthopedic Services

Orthopedic services diagnose and treat problems of bones, joints, muscles, ligaments, tendons, and related movement systems.

Orthopedist

A physician who diagnoses and treats problems of bones, joints, muscles, ligaments, tendons, and related tissues. Treatment may include rehabilitation, medicines, injections, or surgery.

Alternate Names:
Orthopedic Surgeon; Orthopedist Surgeon

Orthopnea

Shortness of breath that occurs or worsens when lying flat and improves when sitting or standing. It may occur with heart failure, lung disease, or other conditions.

Orthopneic Position

An upright seated posture, sometimes with the arms supported or the upper body leaning forward, that can reduce breathlessness. The term is also used for the posture assumed by a person with orthopnea, which commonly occurs in cardiopulmonary disease.

Orthopnoea

Alternate spelling; see *Orthopnea*.

Orthopoxvirus

A genus of poxviruses that includes variola, mpox, vaccinia, and cowpox viruses. Infection may cause fever and skin lesions; severity and transmission depend on the specific virus.

Orthoptera

The insect order containing grasshoppers, crickets, katydids, and locusts; some species cause bites, allergies, or crop-related health effects.

Orthoptic

Relating to assessment and treatment of binocular vision, eye alignment, and disorders such as strabismus.

Orthoptist

An eye-care professional who assesses and treats problems with eye movement, eye alignment, and the use of both eyes together. Orthoptists commonly help manage strabismus, amblyopia, double vision, and some vision problems in children and adults.

Orthoreovirus

A genus of nonenveloped, segmented double-stranded RNA viruses; human infection is often mild or asymptomatic but can occasionally cause disease.

Orthorexia

A term used for an excessive or rigid preoccupation with eating foods considered healthy. It is not a universally recognized formal psychiatric diagnosis but may cause nutritional or social impairment.

Orthorexia Nervosa

A term used for an unhealthy preoccupation with eating foods considered pure or healthy, leading to severe restriction, distress, or impaired daily life. It is not a formal standalone diagnosis in major classification systems.

Orthoscopic

Orthoscopic means providing a straight or undistorted view, as in an optical instrument or examination.

Orthosis

A brace, splint, shoe insert, or similar device worn outside the body to support, align, protect, or improve movement of a body part. Unlike a prosthesis, it does not replace a missing body part.

Orthostatic Hypotension

A sustained fall in systolic blood pressure of at least 20 mm Hg or diastolic pressure of at least 10 mm Hg within three minutes of standing. It may cause dizziness, blurred vision, weakness, or fainting and can result from volume depletion, medicines, or autonomic dysfunction.

Orthostatic Hypotension and Autonomic Failure

Disorders in which autonomic nerves or their central pathways cannot maintain blood pressure and other automatic body functions. They may cause orthostatic hypotension, faintness, urinary or bowel dysfunction, sweating abnormalities, sexual dysfunction, or impaired heart-rate responses.

Orthostatic Intolerance

Dizziness, fast heartbeat, weakness, blurred vision, fatigue, or faintness that develops or worsens on standing because the body does not maintain blood flow to the brain adequately. Causes include dehydration, medicines, nerve disorders, and some chronic conditions.

Orthotic

Orthotic means relating to a brace, splint, insert, or device that supports, aligns, protects, or improves function of a body part.

Orthotic Devices

External supports that hold, align, protect, or assist a body part, such as a brace, splint, shoe insert, or spinal support. They can reduce pain and improve movement, but poor fit may cause pressure, numbness, skin injury, or restricted circulation.

Orthotic Training

Instruction and practice for safely using a brace or other support. It includes putting it on and removing it, checking skin, cleaning it, walking with it, and recognizing problems needing review.

Orthotopic

Situated in the usual anatomical location. In transplantation, an orthotopic graft is placed where the corresponding organ normally lies; compare *Heterotopic*.

Ortolani Maneuver

A hip examination in infants used to look for a dislocated hip that can be gently moved back into place. The clinician bends and moves the leg outward while feeling for a distinct clunk as the hip

enters the socket. This positive finding suggests developmental dysplasia of the hip; a simple click is not the same.

Alternate Names:
Ortolani's Sign; Hip Reduction Maneuver

Ortolani Sign

A distinct clunk felt when a clinician gently moves an infant's hip outward and a dislocated hip slips back into its socket. This is a positive finding that may indicate developmental dysplasia of the hip; a simple click is not the same finding.

Ortolani's Sign

A palpable or audible clunk produced when a dislocated but reducible infant hip is gently abducted and reduced; it is a screening sign of developmental dysplasia of the hip.

Ortolani's Test

Alternate name; see *Ortolani Maneuver*.

Os

A bone or bony structure; in Latin anatomical terminology it means bone, while in obstetrics it means an opening.

Osborn Wave

A notch or extra wave on an electrocardiogram, classically seen with hypothermia. It can also occur in other conditions; its significance depends on body temperature and other findings.

Alternate Names:
J Wave; Hypothermic Wave

Oscillation

Repeated movement or variation around a central position or value.

Oscillator

A device or system that produces repeated movement or an electrical signal at regular intervals.

Oscillograph

An instrument or computer display that records a changing signal over time. It can show electrical, sound, pressure, or movement waves and has been used in medical tests to study signals from the heart, brain, muscles, or breathing.

Oscillometry

A method that measures pressure-related vibrations, commonly used by automated blood-pressure cuffs and some vascular devices. The result estimates blood pressure or blood-flow characteristics but may be inaccurate with movement or irregular rhythms.

Oscillopsia

The disturbing illusion that the visual environment is moving or bouncing, often caused by vestibular or eye-movement dysfunction.

Oscitation

Yawning, a reflex involving opening the mouth and deep inhalation that is associated with sleepiness, fatigue, or other physiologic states.

Oseltamivir

An antiviral medicine used to treat or prevent influenza, with the greatest benefit when started early.

Alternate Names:
Tamiflu

Oseltamivir Phosphate

Oseltamivir phosphate is the salt form of oseltamivir, an antiviral medicine used for treatment or prevention of influenza.

OSFED

A recognized eating-disorder category in which symptoms cause significant distress or interfere with health or daily life but do not meet every criterion for another named eating disorder. The abbreviation means other specified feeding or eating disorder.

Osgood-Schlatter Disease

Painful irritation of the growing area where the kneecap tendon attaches to the shinbone. It commonly affects active children and teenagers and causes tenderness or swelling below the knee.

Osler Nodes

Tender red or purple lumps on the pads of the fingers or toes. They can occur with infective endocarditis and some other conditions; they are a suggestive but nonspecific finding.

Osler Triad

The combination of pneumococcal pneumonia, pneumococcal endocarditis, and pneumococcal meningitis, also called Austrian syndrome. The endocarditis classically affects the aortic valve. It is a rare invasive manifestation of *Streptococcus pneumoniae* infection.

Alternate Names:
Austrian Syndrome

Osler-Weber-Rendu Disease

An autosomal dominant vascular disorder, also called hereditary hemorrhagic telangiectasia, characterized by recurrent nosebleeds, mucocutaneous telangiectasias, and arteriovenous malformations in organs such as the lungs, brain, liver, and gastrointestinal tract. Pathogenic variants most often involve *ENG* or *ACVRL1*; *SMAD4* and *GDF2* are also associated.

Alternate Names:
Hereditary Hemorrhagic Telangiectasia; HHT

Osmidrosis

Strong, unpleasant body odor caused when skin bacteria break down sweat and skin oils. It commonly affects the armpits or feet and may improve with washing, dry clothing, antiperspirants, treatment of skin infection, or assessment of an underlying condition.

Osmium

A dense metallic element; some osmium compounds are highly toxic and can damage the eyes and respiratory tract.

Osmolal Gap

The difference between measured and calculated serum osmolality. A raised gap can indicate unmeasured particles, including toxic alcohols, but is not specific to them; interpretation depends on the formula, substances present, and clinical context.

Alternate Names:
Osmolar Gap

Osmolality

A measure of the number of dissolved particles per kilogram of solvent, usually water. Blood osmolality depends mainly on sodium, glucose, and urea and helps determine how water moves between the bloodstream and cells.

Osmolality Blood Test

A blood osmolality test measures the concentration of dissolved particles in blood and helps assess hydration, electrolyte disorders, and certain poisonings.

Osmolality Urine Test

A urine osmolality test measures how concentrated the urine is and helps evaluate the kidneys' ability to regulate water balance.

Osmolar

Describing a liquid according to the number of dissolved particles in each liter. This property affects water movement between body compartments and helps clinicians assess blood chemistry, hydration, kidney function, and intravenous fluids.

Osmolarity

The concentration of osmotically active particles per liter of solution.

Osmole

A unit representing the amount of a substance that contributes one mole of osmotically active particles.

Osmoreceptor

A sensory cell or neural receptor that detects changes in osmotic concentration, especially in the hypothalamus.

Osmoregulation

Control of water and dissolved-solute balance in the body or an organism, maintaining appropriate cell

volume and internal concentration.

Osmosis

Movement of water through a membrane toward the side with more dissolved particles. This process helps determine how water is distributed between blood, cells, and surrounding tissues.

Osmotic Demyelination Syndrome

Serious brain injury that can occur when long-standing low blood sodium is corrected too quickly. Symptoms may appear days later and include confusion, difficulty speaking or swallowing, weakness, movement problems, or reduced consciousness.

Osmotic Diarrhea

Diarrhea caused by poorly absorbed solutes retaining water in the intestinal lumen. It typically improves with fasting and may result from carbohydrate malabsorption, laxatives, or other osmotically active substances.

Osmotic Diuresis

Increased urine production caused by poorly reabsorbed solutes in the kidney tubules, such as glucose during marked hyperglycemia.

Osmotic Fragility Test

A test that measures the susceptibility of red blood cells to haemolysis when placed in progressively more dilute saline solutions. Increased fragility supports hereditary spherocytosis, although the result may also be affected by other haemolytic disorders and recent transfusion.

Osmotic Pressure

The force that draws water across a membrane toward the side containing more dissolved particles. It helps control how water moves between blood, cells, and surrounding tissues.

Os Odontoideum

Os odontoideum is a separate ossicle near the second cervical vertebra's odontoid process that can cause atlantoaxial instability or spinal-cord risk.

Osseointegration

The firm attachment of living bone to the surface of an implant, such as a dental implant or artificial joint. Good stability, healthy bone, healing, and infection control support this process.

Osseous

Relating to or composed of bone. For example, an osseous lesion is a bone lesion.

Osseous Metaplasia

Osseous metaplasia is formation of mature bone in tissue where bone is not normally present, sometimes after injury, inflammation, or within a lesion.

Ossicle

A small bone, especially one of the three tiny middle-ear bones. The malleus, incus, and stapes transmit eardrum vibrations to the inner ear, allowing sound to be heard.

Ossicles

Alternate plural; see *Ossicle*.

Ossicular Discontinuity

Partial or complete separation of the middle-ear ossicles, usually caused by trauma, chronic ear disease, or surgery. It produces conductive hearing loss and may be evaluated with otoscopy, audiometry, and imaging.

Alternate Names:
Ossicular Chain Discontinuity; Ossicular Disruption

Ossicular Fusion

Abnormal joining or fixation of the middle-ear ossicles (malleus, incus, or stapes), which can restrict sound transmission and cause conductive hearing loss. Evaluation and treatment depend on the underlying congenital, inflammatory, traumatic, or postoperative cause.

Ossicular Prosthesis

An artificial replacement or support for one or more middle-ear ossicles, used during ear surgery to restore sound transmission in selected conductive hear-

ing loss.

Ossification

The formation of bone. It occurs during growth and fracture healing and can also happen abnormally in soft tissues after severe injury, burns, or nervous-system damage.

Ossifying Fibroma

An ossifying fibroma is a usually benign fibro-osseous tumor that replaces normal bone with fibrous tissue and mineralized material, often in the jaw.

Osteitis

Inflammation of bone caused by infection, injury, inflammatory disease, or another process. It may cause localized pain, swelling, warmth, reduced movement, or fever; treatment depends on the cause and extent of bone injury.

Osteitis Deformans

Alternate name; see *Paget Disease Of Bone*.

Osteitis Fibrosa

Weakening of bone caused by prolonged high levels of parathyroid hormone. In severe cases, bone may be replaced by fibrous tissue and develop painful weak spots.

Osteitis Fibrosa Cystica

A rare, severe bone complication of long-standing hyperparathyroidism. Excess parathyroid hormone causes bone to break down, become weak, and sometimes form cyst-like areas called brown tumors. It may cause bone pain, deformity, or fractures.

Alternate Names:
Von Recklinghausen Disease Of Bone

Osteitis Pubis

A usually noninfectious inflammation or stress-related disorder of the pubic symphysis and nearby tissues, causing pain in the groin or lower abdomen. It may follow athletic overuse, pelvic surgery, pregnancy, or childbirth.

Osteoarthritis

The most common form of arthritis, characterized by the gradual wear and breakdown of the smooth protective cartilage that cushions the ends of bones within joints. As the cartilage wears away, underlying bone surfaces rub together, leading to joint pain, stiffness (especially after periods of inactivity), swelling, bony spurs, and reduced joint mobility, most frequently affecting the knees, hips, hands, and spine.

Alternate Names:
Degenerative Joint Disease (DJD); Arthrosis

Osteoarthritis Of The Foot

Osteoarthritis affecting one or more foot joints, often causing pain, stiffness, or swelling with standing and walking. It commonly affects the big-toe joint or the middle of the foot; see also *Osteoarthritis*.

Osteoarthropathy

Osteoarthropathy is disease affecting bones and joints, often describing degenerative, hypertrophic, metabolic, or systemic-associated changes.

Osteoarthrosis

Another name for osteoarthritis, a joint disorder in which cartilage and nearby bone gradually change, causing pain, stiffness, and reduced movement.

Osteoblast

A specialized bone-forming cell derived from mesenchymal stem cells that synthesizes and secretes unmineralized organic bone matrix (osteoid, predominantly type I collagen) and facilitates its subsequent mineralization with calcium hydroxyapatite.

Osteoblastoma

A rare benign bone-forming tumor, usually in the spine or long bones, that can cause persistent pain and sometimes neurologic symptoms.

Osteoblasts

Plural form; see *Osteoblast*.

Osteocalcin

A protein made mainly by osteoblasts that participates in bone mineralization and serves as a marker of bone formation.

Osteocalcin Assay

A blood test measuring osteocalcin, a protein made by bone-forming cells. It can provide information about bone formation and turnover, but results are affected by age, kidney function, medicines, and the laboratory method.

Osteochondritis

Inflammation or injury involving bone and its overlying cartilage, often near a joint. The term includes conditions such as osteochondritis dissecans, in which a fragment may loosen.

Osteochondritis Dissecans

An area of damaged bone and cartilage beneath a joint surface that may loosen or separate. It most often affects the knee in adolescents and young adults and can cause activity-related pain, swelling, catching, or locking. Treatment depends on lesion stability, age, and symptoms.

Osteochondroma

A usually noncancerous cartilage-covered growth projecting from the surface of a bone, often near a growth plate. It may be single or occur as multiple inherited growths and can cause pain, deformity, or pressure on nearby nerves or vessels.

Osteochondromatosis

A term used for the formation of multiple osteochondromas, cartilage-capped bony outgrowths arising near growth plates. The hereditary form is called hereditary multiple osteochondromas or multiple hereditary exostoses and can cause deformity or compression of nearby nerves and vessels. It is distinct from synovial chondromatosis.

Osteochondrosis

A general name for several disorders affecting developing bone and nearby cartilage, often near a growth area or joint. The specific condition depends on the bone and age involved; it may cause pain, swelling, stiffness, or limited movement.

Osteoclasis

Deliberate surgical breaking or manipulation of a bone to correct a deformity or restore alignment. It requires stabilization while the bone heals and may cause bleeding, infection, or nerve injury.

Osteoclast

A large, multinucleated, specialized bone-resorbing cell derived from monocyte/macrophage hematopoietic precursors that degrades the organic and inorganic extracellular matrix of bone.

Osteoclastoma

See *Giant Cell Tumor Of Bone*.

Osteoclasts

Plural form; see *Osteoclast*.

Osteocyte

The most abundant and long-lived cell type in mature bone tissue, representing terminally differentiated osteoblasts that have become entombed within individualized lacunar spaces throughout the mineralized bone matrix.

Osteocytes

Plural form; see *Osteocyte*.

Osteodystrophy

Abnormal bone growth, strength, or renewal caused by a body-wide or metabolic disorder. It may result from kidney disease, mineral imbalance, hormone problems, or inherited conditions and can cause pain or fractures.

Osteofibrous Dysplasia

A usually benign bone lesion that mainly affects the shinbone in young children. It can cause a painless swelling or gradual bowing of the leg, and rarely weakens the bone enough to cause a fracture. It is distinct from fibrous dysplasia, though the names and imaging findings can be similar.

Osteogenesis

The formation and development of bone. It occurs in the growing skeleton and during fracture repair. Abnormal osteogenesis can contribute to birth disorders, poor healing, or fragile bones.

Osteogenesis Imperfecta

A group of genetic disorders, also called brittle bone disease, in which bones break easily, sometimes after mild injury or for no clear reason. The disorders are often caused by gene changes that reduce or alter type I collagen, a protein that gives strength to bone and other connective tissues. Osteogenesis imperfecta is present from birth and can range from mild to severe; severe forms may cause fractures before birth. Other features may include short height, loose joints, blue or gray whites of the eyes, hearing loss, weak or discolored teeth, weak muscles, or a curved spine.

Alternate Names:
Brittle Bone Disease

Osteogenic Sarcoma

A cancerous bone tumor whose cells make immature bone tissue. It often develops near the ends of growing long bones and may cause persistent pain, swelling, reduced movement, or a fracture.

Osteoid

The newly formed, unmineralized organic framework of bone, produced mainly by osteoblasts. Minerals are later deposited in it to make mature hard bone.

Osteoid Osteoma

A small noncancerous bone tumor, usually in an adolescent or young adult. It often causes persistent pain that is worse at night and may improve with anti-inflammatory medicine; scans help locate it and guide treatment.

Osteology

The study of bones, including their structure, development, function, injuries, and diseases. It supports the assessment and treatment of fractures, bone deformities, weak bones, infections, and bone tumors.

Osteolysis

Osteolysis is progressive destruction or resorption of bone caused by tumors, inflammation, prosthesis reactions, infection, metabolic disease, or other processes.

Osteolytic

Causing or characterized by breakdown and loss of bone tissue. Osteolytic lesions can weaken bones and occur with cancers, infections, inflammation, metabolic disorders, or excessive activity of bone-removing cells.

Osteoma

A benign, slow-growing tumor made of bone. It often develops in the skull or facial bones and may cause no symptoms unless it blocks a passage or presses on nearby structures.

Osteoma Cutis

Osteoma cutis is formation of bone within the skin or subcutaneous tissue, occurring as a primary disorder or secondary to acne, trauma, or another condition.

Osteomalacia

Osteomalacia is inadequate mineralization of adult bone, commonly from vitamin-D deficiency or phosphate disorders, causing bone pain, weakness, and fractures.

Osteomyelitis

A serious infection of the bone and bone marrow, usually caused by bacteria or fungi. Microorganisms can reach bone tissue through the bloodstream from an infection elsewhere in the body, through an open fracture or penetrating wound, or by spreading from adjacent infected skin or soft tissues. It causes localized bone pain, swelling, tenderness, warmth, and fever, and can lead to irreversible bone damage or necrosis if not treated promptly.

Osteomyelitis In Children

Childhood osteomyelitis is infection of bone, often caused by bacteria entering through blood or trauma, producing pain, fever, swelling, and impaired movement.

Osteon

The fundamental microscopic, cylindrical structural unit of compact (cortical) bone tissue (Haversian system), consisting of concentric lamellae of mineralized bone matrix surrounding a central Haversian canal.

Osteonecrosis

Death of bone tissue caused by reduced or interrupted blood flow; it is also called avascular necrosis. Causes include injury, certain diseases, long-term corticosteroid use, and heavy alcohol use, though sometimes the cause is unknown. Bone near a joint may collapse, leading to pain and joint damage.

Alternate Names:
Avascular Necrosis; Aseptic Necrosis; Ischemic Bone Necrosis; AVN

Osteonecrosis Of The Jaw

Death of jawbone tissue. Medication-related osteonecrosis of the jaw is associated with antiresorptive or antiangiogenic drugs and is characterized by exposed bone, or bone probeable through a fistula, persisting for more than eight weeks in the absence of jaw radiation or metastatic disease to the jaw. Radiation-related jaw necrosis is termed osteoradionecrosis.

Alternate Names:
Medication-Related Osteonecrosis Of The Jaw; MRONJ

Osteonectin

An extracellular-matrix protein involved in collagen organization, mineral binding, and tissue remodeling.

Alternate Names:
SPARC

Osteons

Plural form; see *Osteon*.

Osteopath

A physician trained in medicine and surgery who earns a Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine degree.

Alternate Names:
Doctor of Osteopathic Medicine; DO

Osteopathy

A term with different meanings by country. In the United States, osteopathic medicine is full-scope physician practice by doctors of osteopathic medicine (DOs), who may use osteopathic manipulative treatment. In the United Kingdom, osteopathy refers to a regulated form of manual diagnosis and treatment, mainly for musculoskeletal problems; it is a distinct profession from medical doctors.

Osteopenia

Bone density that is below the usual range but does not meet the bone-density threshold for osteoporosis. In some adults, a DXA scan describes osteopenia with a T-score between -1.0 and -2.5; this range is not used to classify everyone. Fracture risk also depends on age, previous fractures, falls, medicines, and other health factors.

Osteopetrosis

A rare inherited disorder in which old bone is not removed normally. Bones become unusually dense but brittle and may fracture; crowding of the bone marrow and nerves can cause anemia, infections, vision loss, or other problems.

Osteophyte

A bony outgrowth forming at the edge of a joint, commonly with osteoarthritis. It may cause stiffness, pain, reduced movement, or pressure on nearby nerves, although some osteophytes cause no symptoms.

Osteoplasty

Surgery to repair, reshape, or reconstruct bone to restore structure, movement, or function. The technique depends on the bone problem and may be combined with fixation, grafting, or joint surgery.

Osteopoikilosis

Osteopoikilosis is an inherited benign bone condition with multiple small dense spots on imaging, usually asymptomatic and discovered incidentally.

Osteopontin

A protein involved in bone remodeling, immune responses, inflammation, and attachment between cells and tissues. Its level may change in several diseases, but a measurement is not by itself a specific diagnosis.

Osteoporosis

A progressive skeletal condition characterized by reduced bone mineral density and deterioration of bone structure, causing bones to become fragile, porous, and prone to fractures. It develops when the body loses bone mass faster than it can rebuild it, often progressing silently without pain or symptoms until a fracture occurs—commonly in the hip, spine, or wrist—even from a minor fall or ordinary daily movement.

Alternate Names:
Brittle Bones; Low Bone Density

Osteoporosis Of The Hip

Osteoporosis is a disease that weakens bones throughout the body, including the hip bones, and raises the chance of fracture. It is not a condition limited to the hip; see *Osteoporosis*.

Osteoporosis Fracture Risk Assessment

An estimate of a person's probability of fracture over a defined period, using factors such as age, bone density, previous fractures, falls, medicines, family history, and other health conditions. Tools such as FRAX combine clinical risk factors with or without bone-density measurements.

Osteoporotic Fracture

A fracture resulting from weakened, porous bone after a low-energy event that would not usually break healthy bone.

Osteoradionecrosis

Death of bone within an area treated with radiation, most often the jaw after head-and-neck cancer treatment. The bone may become exposed or fail to heal after injury or dental work and can become infected.

Osteosarcoma

A primary bone cancer in which tumor cells make osteoid, the early tissue that forms bone. It most often starts in a long bone near the knee or shoulder and occurs mainly in children, adolescents, and young adults, though it can develop in other bones and at older ages. It may cause persistent bone pain, swelling, or a fracture.

Osteosclerosis

Abnormally increased bone density seen on imaging or examination. It may result from inherited disease, altered bone renewal, chronic stress, inflammation, medicines, or cancer; dense bone can still be weak or painful.

Osteosynthesis

Surgical repair and stabilization of a broken bone using implants such as plates, screws, rods, nails, or wires. The implants hold the pieces in alignment while the bone heals.

Osteotome

A sharp surgical instrument used to cut or shape bone.

Osteotomy

A surgical procedure involving cutting and repositioning of bone to correct deformity, realign joint surfaces, alter weight-bearing forces, or change limb length.

Osteotomy Of The Knee

Surgery that cuts and reshapes a knee-region bone to correct alignment and redistribute weight across the joint.

Ostium

A natural opening into or out of an organ, cavity, blood vessel, or duct. It allows air, fluid, or other contents to pass between connected body spaces.

Ostomy

A surgically created opening that connects part of the bowel or urinary tract to the skin so stool or

urine can leave the body. A colostomy or ileostomy passes stool; a urostomy passes urine. A pouch usually collects the output and protects the surrounding skin.

Ostomy Appliance

A pouching system that collects stool or urine from a surgically created opening in the abdomen. Colostomy and ileostomy appliances collect stool; urostomy appliances collect urine. Leakage or poor fit can irritate or injure the surrounding skin.

Ostraceous Psoriasis

A rare severe form of psoriasis in which plaques become very thick, hard, and layered, resembling an oyster shell. It can be difficult to treat and may involve extensive skin thickening and fissuring.

Otalgia

The medical term for earache or ear pain. It is divided into two main types: primary and referred. Primary ear pain originates directly inside the ear, most often caused by middle ear infections, swimmer's ear (infection of the outer ear canal), buildup of earwax, pressure changes, or eardrum injury. Referred ear pain comes from nearby body parts that share the same sensory nerves with the ear, including tooth decay, jaw joint problems (temporomandibular joint issues), throat infections, or neck strain. Doctors find the cause by inspecting the ear canal and eardrum with a lighted scope (otoscope) and checking the teeth, mouth, and jaw when the ear looks healthy.

Alternate Names:
Earache; Ear Pain

Othello Syndrome

A delusional belief that a partner is unfaithful despite insufficient evidence; it may occur with psychiatric, neurologic, or substance-related disorders.

Other Pain Conditions

Pain conditions that do not fit neatly into a single category, including nociplastic pain, fibromyalgia, chronic tension-type headache, temporomandibular pain, chronic pelvic pain, and complex regional pain syndrome. Diagnosis and treatment depend on the specific condition.

Otic Barotrauma

Injury to the ear caused by failure to equalize pressure during flying, diving, or other pressure changes.

Otic Capsule

The dense part of the skull bone that surrounds and protects the inner ear, including the hearing and balance organs. Disease or abnormal remodeling in this bone can affect hearing or balance.

Otic Ointment

A semisolid medicine formulated for application to the outer ear or ear canal. Some preparations can injure inner-ear structures if they pass through a perforated eardrum.

Otitis

Inflammation of the ear, which may be infectious or noninfectious. Otitis externa affects the ear canal, otitis media affects the middle ear, and inner-ear inflammation may cause vertigo or hearing loss. Symptoms can include pain, fever, blockage, discharge, or reduced hearing and vary with the location and cause.

Otitis Externa

Inflammation or infection of the ear canal, often called swimmer's ear. It can cause pain, itching, swelling, tenderness, or discharge, and may make hearing feel blocked.

Alternate Names:
Swimmer's Ear; External Otitis; Tropical Ear

Otitis Media

Inflammation or infection of the middle ear, the air-filled space located directly behind the eardrum. It often develops after a common cold or respiratory virus causes swelling that blocks the eustachian tube, trapping fluid and allowing bacteria or viruses to multiply. Commonly affecting infants and young children, it typically causes sharp ear pain, fever, irritability, fluid drainage, and temporary muffled hearing.

Otitis Media With Effusion

Fluid behind the eardrum without signs of an active middle-ear infection. It may make hearing seem muffled and often clears on its own, but long-lasting fluid can affect hearing and speech development in children.

Otoacoustic Emissions

Very soft sounds naturally produced by a healthy inner ear that can be measured with a small probe placed in the ear canal. The test is quick and painless and is commonly used to screen newborn hearing and assess inner-ear function.

Alternate Names:
OAE; Cochlear Emissions

Otocephaly

A severe congenital craniofacial malformation characterized by absent or markedly underdeveloped mandible, ventral displacement or fusion of the ears, and associated facial and airway abnormalities. It is usually lethal because of profound impairment of breathing and feeding.

Otolaryngologist

An otolaryngologist is a physician specializing in disorders of the ear, nose, throat, head, neck, voice, swallowing, and related surgery.

Otolaryngology

The medical specialty treating disorders of the ears, nose, throat, head, and neck. Specialists manage hearing, balance, breathing, swallowing, voice, sinus, facial, and related surgical problems.

Alternate Names:
Otorhinolaryngology; ENT

Otolith

A calcium carbonate (calcite) crystalline structure embedded within the gelatinous otolithic membrane covering the sensory maculae of the utricle and saccule within the inner ear vestibular system.

Otolithiasis

Displacement of calcium carbonate crystals (otoconia) from the utricle into a semicircular canal or onto its sensory cupula. This can cause brief episodes of positional vertigo, as in benign paroxysmal positional vertigo.

Alternate Names:
Otoconial Displacement

Otoliths

Plural form; see *Otolith*.

Otology

The study and medical care of the ear and hearing.

Otomycosis

A fungal infection of the ear canal. It can cause itching, pain, a blocked feeling, reduced hearing, and white or dark debris in the ear.

Alternate Names:
Fungal Otitis Externa; Mycotic Otitis

Otoplasty

Surgery to alter the shape, position, or proportion of the external ear, commonly to correct prominent or congenital ear differences.

Otorhinolaryngology

Alternate name; see *Otolaryngology*.

Otorrhea

Fluid, pus, blood, or other discharge flowing from the ear. Causes include infection, eardrum perforation, injury, or a growth; persistent, bloody, foul-smelling, or clear discharge can indicate significant disease. Clear watery discharge after a head injury may be cerebrospinal fluid.

Otorrhoea

Alternate spelling; see *Otorrhea*.

Otosalpingitis

Inflammation, mucosal edema, and catarrhal obstruction of the Eustachian tube connecting the middle ear to the nasopharynx, predisposing to negative middle ear pressure, tympanic membrane retraction, and serous otitis media.

Alternate Names:
Eustachian Salpingitis; Tubotympanitis

Otosclerosis

A condition in which one of the tiny middle-ear bones becomes fixed and cannot move freely. Sound then does not pass well to the inner ear, gradually reducing hearing.

Otoscope

A lighted instrument used to examine the ear canal and eardrum. It can help identify earwax, infection, a foreign object, fluid, swelling, or a perforated eardrum. Examination findings are interpreted with symptoms and, when needed, hearing tests.

Otoscopy

Looking into the ear canal and at the eardrum with a lighted instrument called an otoscope. It can help find earwax, infection, a foreign object, a hole in the eardrum, fluid, or other causes of ear symptoms.

Ototoxicity

Damage to the inner ear from a medicine, chemical, or other toxic exposure. It may cause hearing loss, ringing in the ears, dizziness, or imbalance and can be temporary or permanent.

Alternate Names:
Ear Toxicity

Ottawa Ankle Rules

A clinical guide for deciding whether an ankle or foot X-ray is needed after an injury. An ankle X-ray is indicated for pain near the ankle bones with tenderness at the back edge or tip of either ankle bone, or inability to take four steps both after injury and at assessment. A foot X-ray is indicated for midfoot pain with tenderness at the navicular or base of the fifth metatarsal, or the same inability to take four steps.

Ounce

A unit of mass or fluid volume whose exact conversion depends on the measurement system; the same word can refer to different quantities in different systems.

Outcome

The result or final effect of a disease, treatment, exposure, or healthcare intervention. Outcomes may include recovery, symptom control, complications, disability, quality of life, or death and can be measured in different ways.

Outcome Measurement

The use of defined measures to assess a patient's symptoms, function, quality of life, or other results before and after care.

Outer Ear

The visible auricle and the external auditory canal, which collect and conduct sound toward the eardrum.

Outer Ear Infection

Alternate name; see *Swimmer's Ear*.

Outpatient

A person who receives medical evaluation or treatment without being admitted overnight to a hospital or other inpatient facility.

Outpatient Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided without hospital admission to improve function after illness, injury, surgery, or disability. The setting, frequency, and duration are individualized.

Output

The amount of a substance produced or eliminated by the body or by an organ over a specified time, such as urine output or cardiac output.

Ova

Plural of ovum; eggs or egg cells, and in parasitology, eggs of worms or other parasites.

Ovalocyte Count

An ovalocyte count estimates the number or proportion of oval-shaped red blood cells on a blood smear and may help evaluate anemia.

Ovarian

Relating to an ovary. The ovaries release eggs and produce hormones. Ovarian problems include cysts, inflammation, reduced function, twisting that cuts off blood supply, and tumors; sudden severe pelvic pain may indicate torsion.

Ovarian (Adnexal) Torsion

Twisting of an ovary, often together with its fallopian tube, around its blood supply. Sudden unilateral pelvic pain, nausea, or vomiting may occur; it is a surgical emergency because prolonged torsion can cause ovarian necrosis.

Ovarian Cancer

A type of cancer that begins in the ovaries, fallopian tubes, or the peritoneal lining of the abdomen. Because early symptoms—such as persistent abdominal bloating, pelvic discomfort, feeling full quickly when eating, and urinary changes—are subtle and easily mistaken for digestive issues, the cancer is often detected at an advanced stage. It most commonly affects older women, and individuals with a family history or specific inherited genetic variations (such as *BRCA1* or *BRCA2*) have an increased risk.

Alternate Names:
Ovarian Carcinoma; Malignant Ovarian Neoplasm; Ovarian Malignancy

Ovarian Carcinoid

Alternate form; see *Ovarian Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Ovarian Cyst

A fluid-filled or partly solid sac that develops within or on the surface of an ovary. Most are harmless functional cysts that form during normal menstrual cycles and resolve spontaneously within a few weeks to months without causing symptoms. Larger or complex cysts can cause pelvic aching, lower abdominal pressure, or bloating, and can lead to severe sudden pain if they rupture or cause the ovary to twist (ovarian torsion).

Alternate Names:
Ovarian Cysts; Ovarian Fluid-Filled Sacs

Ovarian Cyst Rupture

Breakage of an ovarian cyst that may cause sudden pelvic pain and internal bleeding or, if the cyst is infected, fever and inflammation. Assessment depends on vital signs, pregnancy testing, ultrasound, blood loss, and the severity and persistence of symptoms.

Ovarian Cysts

Plural form; see *Ovarian Cyst*.

Alternate Names:
Ovarian Fluid-Filled Sacs

Ovarian Dysgerminomas

Malignant ovarian germ-cell tumors that occur most often in adolescents and young adults. They may present as a rapidly enlarging pelvic mass or pain; treatment commonly involves fertility-sparing surgery with staging and, when indicated, chemotherapy.

Ovarian Failure

Reduced ovarian activity causing irregular or absent periods, difficulty becoming pregnant, and symptoms of low estrogen such as hot flushes or vaginal dryness. When it occurs before age 40, it is usually called primary ovarian insufficiency.

Ovarian Fibromata

Usually noncancerous tumors made of fibrous tissue that develop in an ovary. They may cause no symptoms or produce pelvic pressure, pain, menstrual changes, or fluid in the abdomen when large.

Ovarian Follicle

A small fluid-filled structure in an ovary that contains an immature egg and supporting cells. During each menstrual cycle, one follicle usually matures and releases an egg during ovulation.

Ovarian Gonadoblastoma

A rare tumor containing cells that normally develop into eggs and cells that support sex-hormone production. It often occurs in an atypically developed gonad, may contain Y-chromosome material, and can produce hormones.

Ovarian Hemorrhage

Bleeding into or around an ovary, often from a ruptured cyst or blood vessel. It may cause sudden pelvic pain, weakness, dizziness, or internal blood loss and can require surgical treatment.

Ovarian Hyperstimulation Syndrome

A complication of fertility treatment in which the ovaries enlarge and fluid moves into the abdomen or other tissues. It may cause bloating, pain, vomiting, reduced urine, breathlessness, blood clots, or kidney problems and can be severe.

Alternate Names:
OHSS

Ovarian Induction

Alternate name; see *Ovulation Induction*.

Ovarian Infection

Infection involving an ovary, often as part of pelvic inflammatory disease or an abscess, causing pelvic pain, fever, and abnormal discharge.

Ovarian Insufficiency

Reduced ovarian hormone production or follicular function, which may cause irregular or absent menstruation, infertility, hot flashes, vaginal symptoms, and reduced bone density. The cause, age at onset, pregnancy goals, and associated autoimmune or genetic findings guide evaluation.

Ovarian Metastasis

Cancer that has spread to an ovary from another organ, commonly the digestive tract, breast, or reproductive organs. It may resemble a primary ovarian cancer, so tissue testing is important because treatment depends on the original site.

Ovarian Neuroendocrine Tumor

A rare ovarian tumor arising from cells with neuroendocrine features. It may be a primary ovarian tumor or part of a tumor arising elsewhere, and its behavior ranges from well-differentiated to aggressive disease.

Ovarian Overproduction Of Androgens

Excess production of androgens, such as testosterone, by the ovaries. It may cause acne, increased facial or body hair, irregular periods, or difficulty becoming pregnant.

Ovarian Pregnancy

A rare ectopic pregnancy in which the embryo implants in an ovary. It may cause pelvic pain or internal bleeding and can be difficult to distinguish from other ectopic pregnancies.

Ovarian Reserve

The approximate number of immature eggs (oocytes) remaining in the ovaries. It generally declines with age and may be estimated with blood tests or an ultrasound follicle count. It reflects egg quantity more than egg quality and does not by itself predict whether or when a person can become pregnant.

Ovarian Reserve Testing

Tests that estimate the number of available ovarian follicles, mainly to predict how the ovaries may respond to fertility medicines. They commonly measure anti-Müllerian hormone or follicle-stimulating hormone in blood, or count small follicles by ultrasound. Results do not directly measure egg quality and do not reliably predict natural conception.

Ovarian Rupture

A tear in an ovary or ovarian cyst that may cause sudden pelvic pain and internal bleeding.

Ovarian Stimulation

Use of hormone medicines to make ovarian follicles grow and eggs mature. In in vitro fertilization, the aim is usually to develop several eggs for collection; ovulation induction more often aims to mature one egg. An excessive response can cause ovarian hyperstimulation syndrome.

Ovarian Teratoma

A tumor of an ovary made from reproductive cells that can form different kinds of tissue, such as skin, hair, or bone. Mature teratomas are usually non-

cancerous; immature teratomas can be cancerous.

Ovarian Thecoma

Alternate form; see *Thecoma*.

Ovarian Torsion

Twisting of an ovary, often together with its fallopian tube, that can cut off blood flow. It causes sudden one-sided pelvic pain, often with nausea or vomiting, and is a gynecologic emergency that is usually treated with surgery.

Ovaries

The paired female gonads that produce oocytes and secrete sex hormones, mainly estrogen and progesterone. They are located on either side of the uterus and participate in the menstrual cycle and reproduction.

Alternate Names:
Female Gonads; Oophoron

Ovariotomy

Older term; see *Oophorectomy*.

Ovary

A reproductive organ that contains developing oocytes and produces hormones, including estrogen and progesterone. In most menstrual cycles, an ovary releases an oocyte during ovulation.

Ovary Disease

Any disorder affecting an ovary, including cysts, infection, inflammation, tumors, hormonal dysfunction, torsion, or bleeding.

Ovary Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in an ovary that may be noncancerous, have uncertain behavior, or be cancerous. Symptoms can include bloating, pelvic pain, pressure, or abnormal bleeding, but some growths are found incidentally on imaging.

Overactive Bladder

Alternate name; see *Overactive Bladder Syndrome*.

Overactive Bladder Syndrome

A symptom complex characterized by urinary urgency, with or without urgency urinary incontinence, usually accompanied by daytime frequency and nocturia in the complete absence of a proven urinary tract infection or other obvious local pathological condition.

Alternate Names:
OAB; Overactive Bladder

Overall Survival

The length of time from diagnosis, treatment, or study entry until death from any cause. Doctors and researchers use it to describe how long people live and to compare treatments. It differs from time without worsening disease because it includes survival regardless of whether the illness has progressed.

Overbite

Vertical overlap of the upper front teeth over the lower front teeth; excessive overbite can damage gums, teeth, or jaw function.

Overdenture

A removable denture supported by dental implants or remaining natural teeth. This support can improve stability, chewing, speech, and comfort, while attachments may help preserve jawbone and reduce denture movement.

Overdose

Taking, receiving, or being exposed to more of a medicine or other substance than intended or prescribed. An overdose may or may not cause harm; its effects depend on the substance, amount, formulation, route, timing, and person exposed.

Overflow Incontinence

Involuntary leakage of urine occurring when the intravesical pressure exceeds the outlet resistance in a chronically overdistended, poorly contracting bladder, caused by mechanical bladder outlet obstruction (e.g., benign prostatic hyperplasia) or an acontractile detrusor muscle in diabetic or neurogenic bladder.

Alternate Names:
Paradoxical Incontinence; Overdistension Incontinence

Overflow Urinary Incontinence

Urine leakage caused by a bladder that remains too full because it does not empty properly. Weak flow, difficulty starting, frequent small amounts, dribbling, or constant leakage may occur; blockage or nerve disease can be responsible.

Overgrowth Syndrome

A group of disorders, usually present from birth, in which the whole body, one side, or particular tissues grow more than expected. Examples include Beckwith-Wiedemann syndrome, Sotos syndrome, and PIK3CA-related overgrowth spectrum. Findings may include large body size, asymmetric limb or tissue growth, or an enlarged tongue; tumor risk is increased in some syndromes, such as Beckwith-Wiedemann syndrome, but not in all.

Over-Hydration

Excess accumulation of body water, which may cause edema, dilutional hyponatremia, or heart and lung complications.

Overlap Myositis

Muscle inflammation occurring together with another autoimmune connective-tissue disease, such as lupus, systemic sclerosis, mixed connective-tissue disease, or Sjögren syndrome. It may cause muscle weakness, skin changes, joint symptoms, swallowing problems, or lung disease; treatment is tailored to the affected organs.

Overlapping Autoimmune Syndrome

A condition in which features of two or more defined autoimmune diseases occur in the same person. Examples include systemic sclerosis with myositis and autoimmune hepatitis with primary biliary cholangitis. The term does not require every feature of each disease and is interpreted according to the specific overlap pattern.

Alternate Names:
Overlap Syndrome

Overlay Denture

A removable denture that fits over remaining teeth, roots, or implants to improve support, chewing, and retention.

Over-Nutrition

Excessive intake or accumulation of energy or nutrients that can contribute to obesity, metabolic disease, or toxicity.

Overriding Aorta

A birth-related heart abnormality in which the main artery leaving the heart sits over a hole between the lower chambers and receives blood from both. It commonly occurs as part of tetralogy of Fallot.

Oversedate

To give excessive sedation, causing unusually deep sleep, slowed responses, impaired breathing, or difficulty maintaining the airway.

Over-The-Counter

A medicine available without a prescription for specified conditions. It can still cause side effects, interact with other medicines, or be unsuitable for some health conditions.

Overt Proteinuria

Abnormally high protein loss in the urine that is detectable by routine testing and may indicate kidney disease.

Overuse Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Repetitive Strain Injury*.

Overweight

Body weight above the usual range for height. In adults, a Body Mass Index of 25 to less than 30 kg/m^2 is commonly classified as overweight, but it does not directly measure body fat.

Oviduct

A tube carrying an ovum from the ovary toward the uterus; in humans it is the uterine or fallopian tube.

Ovomucin

A glycoprotein in egg white that contributes to its gel-like viscosity and helps stabilize the egg-white structure.

Ovotesticular Disorder of Sex Development

A difference of sex development in which both ovarian and testicular tissue are present, either in one ovotestis or in separate gonads. Chromosomal patterns and external anatomy vary. The deprecated historical term "true hermaphroditism" may appear in older records; current terms include ovotesticular disorder of sex development and ovotesticular DSD.

Alternate Names:
Ovotesticular DSD; True Hermaphroditism (deprecated historical term)

Ovotesticular Disorder of Sexual Development

A difference of sex development in which a person has both ovarian and testicular tissue, in the same or different gonads. Evaluation is multidisciplinary and considers anatomy, hormones, chromosomes, genetics, fertility, wellbeing, and the person's preferences.

Ovotestis

A gonad containing both ovarian-type and testicular tissue. It is an uncommon difference of sex development and may produce ovarian hormones, testicular hormones, eggs, sperm, or none of these; evaluation is individualized.

Ovulation

Release of a mature egg from an ovarian follicle, usually around the middle of the menstrual cycle.

Ovulation Home Test

An ovulation home test detects the rise in urinary luteinizing hormone that usually occurs shortly before ovulation.

Ovulation Induction

Use of medicines to trigger or regulate ovulation in someone who ovulates rarely or not at all. The medicines help ovarian follicles grow and mature; this treatment may be used alone or with insemination. It differs from IVF stimulation, which usually develops several eggs for collection.

Ovum

A mature female gamete; in humans, the cell released at ovulation is usually a secondary oocyte, which completes its final meiotic division when a sperm enters. The resulting genetic material combines with the sperm's to form a zygote, the first cell of a developing embryo.

Oxacillin

A penicillinase-resistant penicillin used to treat infections caused by susceptible bacteria, especially staphylococci. It is also used in laboratory testing for methicillin resistance.

Oxalate

A dicarboxylic acid anion ($C_2O_4^{2-}$) derived from dietary sources and endogenous glyoxylate metabolism that forms insoluble complexes with calcium, serving as the primary constituent of calcium oxalate nephrolithiasis.

Oxalate Nephropathy

Renal tubular injury and interstitial fibrosis resulting from the intrarenal precipitation and deposition of insoluble calcium oxalate crystals within renal tubular lumens, seen in enteric hyperoxaluria (due to fat malabsorption, Crohn disease, or bariatric surgery) and ethylene glycol intoxication.

Oxalates

Plural form; see *Oxalate*.

Oxalic Acid

A dicarboxylic acid whose oxalate salts can contribute to calcium-oxalate kidney stones; concentrated exposure is toxic.

Oxalic Acid Poisoning

Swallowing oxalic acid can burn the digestive tract

and bind calcium, causing muscle cramps, abnormal heart rhythms, seizures, kidney injury, or shock. It is a medical emergency.

Oxaliplatin

Oxaliplatin is a platinum chemotherapy drug that forms DNA cross-links and is used especially in colorectal cancer regimens; acute cold-triggered neuropathy and cumulative sensory neuropathy are characteristic toxicities.

Oxaloacetate

A small molecule used in the cell's energy-making cycle. It combines with another molecule to begin a step that produces energy and can also help make glucose and the amino acid aspartate.

Oxaluria

Excretion of oxalate in urine. Increased urinary oxalate, called hyperoxaluria, can promote calcium oxalate kidney stones. Causes include inherited metabolic disorders, increased intestinal absorption after fat malabsorption or bowel surgery, and other factors; measurement may be included in a metabolic stone evaluation.

Oxandrolone

An anabolic steroid used in selected conditions involving severe weight loss or catabolic stress; it can affect the liver, lipids, and hormone function.

Oxaprozin

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used to relieve pain and inflammation in conditions such as osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis.

Oxazepam

A benzodiazepine medicine used short-term for anxiety or alcohol withdrawal, causing sleepiness and possible dependence.

Oxazepam Overdose

Taking too much oxazepam, a sedative medicine, can cause severe sleepiness, confusion, poor coordination, slowed breathing, coma, or death, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Oxazole

Oxazole is a five-membered chemical ring containing oxygen and nitrogen that is used as a building block in medicinal and other chemistry.

Oxcarbazepine

Oxcarbazepine is an antiseizure medicine that blocks voltage-gated sodium channels and treats focal seizures; dizziness, ataxia, rash, and clinically important hyponatraemia may occur.

Oxidant

A chemical substance or reactive oxygen species (ROS) that accepts electrons from another molecule in an oxidation-reduction reaction, contributing to cellular oxidative stress when production exceeds antioxidant defenses.

Oxidants

Plural form; see *Oxidant*.

Oxidation

A chemical process that changes a substance through loss of electrons or reaction with oxygen.

Oxidation-Reduction

A chemical reaction involving transfer of electrons, in which one substance is oxidized and another is reduced.

Oxidative Phosphorylation

A process mainly occurring at the inner mitochondrial membrane in which electron transfer drives a proton gradient that powers ATP synthase to produce ATP. It is linked to, but distinct from, the earlier pathways that generate the electron carriers.

Oxidative Stress

A state in which reactive molecules exceed the capacity of antioxidant systems to control them, potentially damaging cell membranes, proteins, and DNA. It is studied in many diseases but is not itself a specific diagnosis.

Oxidoreductase

An enzyme that transfers electrons or hydrogen between molecules during a chemical reaction. These enzymes are important in energy production, drug breakdown, and many other cell processes.

Oxime

A type of chemical compound. Some oximes, such as pralidoxime, are used as emergency antidotes because they can restore an important nerve enzyme after organophosphate pesticide poisoning.

Oximeter

A device that estimates blood oxygen level, usually by shining light through a finger, toe, or earlobe. A pulse oximeter also displays pulse rate, but readings can be affected by movement, poor circulation, or skin factors.

Oximetry

Measurement of oxygen levels in blood or tissue. A pulse oximeter estimates blood oxygen through a skin sensor, while arterial testing measures oxygen more directly; results can be affected by poor circulation or motion.

Oxter

Oxter is an anatomical term for the armpit or axilla.

Oxybuprocaine

A local anaesthetic eye drop that briefly numbs the surface of the eye. It may be used for examinations or short procedures. Repeated use can delay healing and damage the cornea.

Oxycephaly

A cone-shaped skull caused by premature fusion of cranial sutures, also called acrocephaly.

Alternate Names:
Acrocephaly

Oxycodone

Oxycodone is an opioid analgesic used for moderate-to-severe pain; sedation, constipation, respiratory depression, tolerance, dependence, and overdose risk increase with alcohol or other sedatives.

Oxycodone Hydrochloride

Alternate form; see *Oxycodone*.

Oxygen

A gas essential for aerobic metabolism and tissue energy production.

Oxygenases

Enzymes that incorporate oxygen from molecular oxygen into a substrate; monooxygenases add one oxygen atom and dioxygenases add both.

Oxygenated Blood

Blood with a relatively high oxygen content, usually after passing through the lungs. It travels through systemic arteries to tissues; pulmonary arteries carry oxygen-poor blood from the heart to the lungs.

Oxygenation

The process of supplying oxygen to blood and tissues, or the degree to which hemoglobin and tissues are adequately oxygenated.

Oxygenator

A machine that adds oxygen to blood and removes carbon dioxide when the lungs cannot do this adequately. It is used during heart-lung bypass surgery and some forms of extracorporeal life support.

Oxygen Consumption

The amount of oxygen the body uses in a given time. It reflects the body's energy needs and rises with exercise, fever, or illness; it can be measured during exercise testing to assess heart and lung function.

Oxygen Content

The amount of oxygen carried in blood, mainly bound to hemoglobin with a small dissolved component.

Oxygen Delivery

The amount of oxygen transported from the lungs to body tissues each minute. It depends mainly on

cardiac output, the amount of hemoglobin, and how much oxygen the hemoglobin carries. Inadequate delivery can injure organs when the body cannot compensate.

Oxygen Desaturation Index

The number of drops in blood oxygen saturation per hour of sleep or recording time during a sleep study. The report should state the drop threshold used, commonly at least 3% or 4% from baseline, and whether the rate is calculated per hour of sleep or monitoring time.

Oxygen Dissociation Curve

A graph showing how readily hemoglobin in the blood takes up or releases oxygen at different oxygen levels. Temperature, blood acidity, carbon dioxide, and other factors can shift the curve.

Alternate Names:
Oxygen-Hemoglobin Dissociation Curve; Oxyhemoglobin Dissociation Curve

Oxygen Enhancement Ratio

A measure of how much oxygen increases the effect of radiation on cells. It compares the radiation dose needed with little oxygen to the dose needed when oxygen is normal to produce the same amount of cell injury.

Oxygen-Hemoglobin Dissociation Curve

Alternate name; see *Oxygen Dissociation Curve*.

Oxygen Mask

A mask that delivers supplemental oxygen through the nose and mouth. The type and flow rate are selected according to oxygen needs and may be monitored with blood or pulse-oximetry measurements.

Oxygen Pulse

The amount of oxygen used by the body with each heartbeat, estimated during exercise as oxygen uptake divided by heart rate.

Oxygen Safety

Practices that reduce fire, explosion, pressure, and treatment risks during oxygen use, including keeping oxygen away from flames, smoking, oils, and unsafe equipment.

Oxygen Saturation

The percentage of hemoglobin in the blood carrying oxygen. A finger or ear sensor estimates it without taking blood, while an arterial blood test measures it more directly; the healthy target varies with the person's condition.

Oxygen Tent

A canopy or enclosure used to deliver oxygen around a patient's head; modern oxygen masks, nasal cannulas, or ventilatory devices are usually more precise.

Oxygen Therapy

Administration of extra oxygen through a tube, mask, or breathing machine when blood oxygen is too low or expected to fall. It is titrated to oxygen needs because excessive oxygen can also cause harm; oxygen accelerates combustion and creates a fire hazard near flames.

Oxygen Therapy In Infants

Carefully measured extra oxygen given to a baby whose blood oxygen is too low or whose lungs are not exchanging gases adequately. Clinicians monitor oxygen closely because both too little and too much can injure developing organs.

Oxygen Toxicity

Tissue injury caused by exposure to oxygen at excessively high partial pressures or concentrations, potentially affecting the lungs, eyes, or central nervous system.

Oxygen Transport

The movement of oxygen from the lungs to tissues, mainly bound to hemoglobin and partly dissolved in plasma, with delivery affected by blood flow and hemoglobin concentration.

Oxyhaemoglobin

British spelling; see *Oxyhemoglobin*.

Oxyhemoglobin

Hemoglobin bound to oxygen, formed mainly in the lungs and carrying oxygen through arterial blood to tissues.

Oxylipins

Oxylipins are oxygenated fatty-acid derivatives that act as local mediators of inflammation, vascular tone, pain, and other physiologic responses.

Oxymetazoline

A topical alpha-adrenergic agonist used as a nasal decongestant or ocular vasoconstrictor; prolonged nasal use can cause rebound congestion.

Oxymetholone

Oxymetholone is an anabolic steroid used in selected severe anemias; it can cause liver injury, fluid retention, and hormonal side effects.

Oxymorphone

A potent opioid analgesic used for severe pain; it can cause sedation, constipation, dependence, and life-threatening respiratory depression.

Oxyphil Cell

A cell with many mitochondria, giving it a distinctive granular appearance under a microscope. Oxyphil cells occur in tissues such as the parathyroid and thyroid, where their significance depends on the organ and the surrounding findings.

Oxyphil Cell Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Hurthle Cell Carcinoma (Oncocytic Carcinoma)*.

Oxyphilic Adenoma

An oxyphilic adenoma is a usually benign glandular tumor composed of cells rich in mitochondria, such as an oncocytic parathyroid or salivary-gland tumor.

Oxytocic

An agent or drug that stimulates uterine smooth muscle contractions, used to induce or augment labor and control postpartum hemorrhage.

Oxytocics

Plural form; see *Oxytocic*.

Oxytocin

A hormone made in the hypothalamus and released by the posterior pituitary gland. It stimulates uterine contractions during labor and milk ejection during breastfeeding; synthetic oxytocin is used in obstetric care.

Oxytocin Infusion

A controlled drip of synthetic oxytocin into a vein to start or strengthen labor or help control heavy bleeding after birth. Overly strong or frequent contractions can harm the pregnant person or baby.

Oxyuriasis

Infection with pinworms, especially Enterobius vermicularis. The worms commonly cause itching around the anus at night, disturbed sleep, and sometimes abdominal discomfort; treatment usually includes medicine and household hygiene.

Ozaena

British spelling; see *Ozena*.

Ozena

Ozena is a chronic form of atrophic rhinitis with widened nasal passages, crusting, foul odor, and impaired mucosal function.

Ozone

Ozone is a reactive form of oxygen that can irritate and injure the airways and lungs when inhaled, despite useful atmospheric and disinfecting roles.

P

1p36 Deletion Syndrome

A genetic disorder caused by loss of a piece of chromosome 1. It may cause developmental and intellectual disability, small head size, low muscle tone, seizures, hearing loss, heart problems, and distinctive facial features; severity varies.

Alternate Names:
Monosomy 1p36; Chromosome 1p36 Deletion Syndrome

Generalized Pustular Psoriasis

A rare, potentially severe inflammatory skin disease marked by widespread, visible sterile pustules on reddened skin, usually outside the palms and soles and not limited to existing psoriasis plaques. It can occur with or without plaque psoriasis and with or without systemic symptoms such as fever, fatigue, or inflammation affecting other organs. Episodes may recur or persist.

Alternate Names:
Generalised Pustular Psoriasis; GPP

P2Y12 Inhibitors

Medicines that block the P2Y12 receptor on platelets, reducing platelet activation and clot formation. Examples include clopidogrel, prasugrel, ticagrelor, and the intravenous medicine cangrelor.

Alternate Names:
P2Y12 Receptor Antagonists; ADP Receptor Antagonists

P53 Tumor Suppressor

A protein that helps prevent damaged cells from dividing or surviving. Changes in the TP53 gene can allow abnormal cells to multiply and contribute to many cancers, but a gene change alone does not determine a person's outcome.

Pacemaker

A device that senses the heart's electrical activity and sends impulses to maintain or coordinate its rhythm. It may be temporary or permanently implanted; implanted devices may use wires (leads) or be leadless. Pacemakers are used for slow heart rhythms or conduction blocks, and some coordinate the ventricles' contractions.

Alternate Names:
Artificial Pacemaker

Pacemaker Complications

Problems associated with pacemaker implantation or use include pocket bleeding or infection, pneumothorax, cardiac or vascular injury, lead displacement or fracture, venous thrombosis, device malfunction, and pacing-related arrhythmias.

Pacemaker Implantation

A procedure to place a pacemaker under the skin of the chest and connect it to the heart with one or more wires, or place a leadless device inside the heart. The device supports an abnormally slow or unreliable rhythm; the approach depends on the rhythm problem and the person's anatomy.

Pacemaker Malfunction

Failure of a pacemaker system to sense, pace, capture, or communicate as intended. Causes include lead displacement or fracture, battery depletion, programming problems, electromagnetic interference, and myocardial or metabolic factors.

Pacemaker-Mediated Tachycardia

An endless-loop reentrant tachycardia in a dual-chamber tracking pacemaker, usually requiring retrograde ventriculoatrial conduction: a ventricular paced beat conducts back to the atrium and is sensed, triggering another ventricular pace. It may cause palpitations, dizziness, or hemodynamic symptoms.

Pacemakers and Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillators

Implantable devices that provide bradycardia pacing, resynchronization, or detection and treatment of dangerous ventricular arrhythmias. Assessment includes indications, programming, leads, battery status, complications, and follow-up.

Pacemaker Syndrome

Symptoms caused by loss of atrioventricular synchrony or other adverse hemodynamic effects of pacing, most often during right-ventricular pacing. Features may include fatigue, dizziness, hypotension, dyspnea, and prominent neck pulsations.

Pachyderma

Abnormal thickening and coarsening of the skin, which may occur with chronic inflammation, lymphedema, endocrine disease, or pachydermoperiostosis.

Pachydermoperiostosis

The primary form of hypertrophic osteoarthropathy, usually inherited and characterized by thickened oily or furrowed facial skin, enlargement of the fingers and toes, clubbing, and painful periosteal new bone formation. Severity varies, and the disorder may be associated with joint and bone complications.

Pachygyria

A birth-related brain-development abnormality in which the brain's outer surface has fewer, broader folds than usual. It can cause developmental delay, learning difficulties, seizures, movement problems, or other neurologic effects of varying severity.

Pachymeningitis

Inflammation and thickening of the tough outer covering of the brain and spinal cord. It may cause headache, nerve problems, or pressure on the brain and can result from infection, immune disease, or other inflammation.

Pachymetry

Measurement of the thickness of the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It is used to assess corneal disease and helps place eye-pressure readings in context.

Pachyonychia Congenita

An inherited skin disorder causing very thick, abnormal nails and painful thick skin on the palms and soles. Some people also develop blisters, cysts, excess sweating, or white patches in the mouth.

Pacing

Planning activity, rest, and effort to stay within a person's tolerance and limit symptom flare-ups. It is used in rehabilitation and in managing conditions that cause fatigue or pain.

Pacinian Corpuscle

A specialized nerve ending deep in the skin and connective tissue that detects deep pressure and vibration. It helps the nervous system sense contact, movement, and the handling of objects.

Paclitaxel

Paclitaxel is a taxane chemotherapy drug that stabilizes microtubules and prevents cell division; it treats several cancers and can cause myelosuppression, neuropathy, alopecia, myalgia, and hypersensitivity reactions.

Paclitaxel Liposome

A liposomal formulation of paclitaxel designed to alter drug distribution and delivery; paclitaxel disrupts microtubules and is used as chemotherapy in selected cancers.

PACS

A computer system used by healthcare services to store, retrieve, view, and share medical images such as X-rays, CT scans, MRI scans, and ultrasound studies.

Paediatric Surgery

The surgical specialty concerned with congenital and acquired conditions requiring operations in fetuses, newborns, infants, children, and adolescents. It includes neonatal surgery, childhood trauma, and surgical treatment of pediatric tumors.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Surgery

PAES

Alternate name; see *Popliteal Artery Entrapment Syndrome*.

Page Kidney

High blood pressure caused when blood or another mass presses on a kidney from the outside. The pressure activates the kidney's blood-pressure system and may follow injury, bleeding, or treatment with blood thinners.

Paget Disease Of Bone

A chronic disorder of bone remodeling in which bone is broken down rapidly and rebuilt in a disorganized way. One or more bones, often in the pelvis, spine, skull, or legs, may become enlarged, weak, painful, or deformed and may fracture; skull involvement can affect hearing. Many people have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Paget's Disease of Bone; Paget's Disease of Bone; Osteitis Deformans

Paget Disease Of The Anus

Extramammary Paget disease affecting the skin around the anus. It usually appears as a persistent red, itchy, scaly, or sore patch and is an in-situ glandular cancer; an underlying cancer can also be present. Diagnosis requires biopsy, with further evaluation guided by the site and findings.

Paget Disease Of The Breast

A rare breast cancer in which malignant glandular cells involve the skin of the nipple and often the areola. It commonly causes persistent redness, scaling, crusting, or itching of the nipple and is often associated with ductal carcinoma in situ or invasive cancer elsewhere in the breast.

Alternate Names:
Paget Disease Of The Nipple; Paget's Disease of the Nipple; Mammary Paget Disease; Mammary Paget's Disease; Paget's Disease of the Breast; Nipple Paget Disease

Paget Disease Of The Vulva

Extramammary Paget disease affecting vulvar skin. It usually appears as a persistent itchy, red, scaly, or sore patch and is an in-situ glandular cancer; an underlying cancer can also be present. Diagnosis requires biopsy, with further evaluation guided by the site and findings.

Pagetoid Reticulosis

A rare localized variant of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma with solitary slowly enlarging scaly plaques containing atypical pagetoid lymphocytes.

Paget-Schroetter Syndrome

An effort-induced deep vein thrombosis (effort thrombosis) of the axillary-subclavian venous system, typically occurring in young, athletic individuals following repetitive, strenuous upper-extremity overhead exertion (e.g., throwing or weightlifting), caused by extrinsic compression of the vein at the thoracic outlet.

Alternate Names:
Effort Thrombosis of Subclavian Vein; Effort-Induced Axillosubclavian Vein Thrombosis

Paget's Disease

An ambiguous term that may refer to Paget disease of bone or Paget disease of the breast. Paget disease of bone is a chronic disorder of abnormal bone breakdown and regrowth that can enlarge, weaken, or deform bone; mammary Paget disease is a malignancy involving the nipple and areola, often associated with underlying breast cancer.

Paget's Disease of the Nipple

Alternate name; see *Paget Disease Of The Breast*.

Paget's Disease of the Vulva

A rare form of extramammary Paget disease, usually an intraepithelial adenocarcinoma of vulvar skin characterized by Paget cells. It may be associated with an underlying invasive or internal carcinoma and often appears as a persistent eczematous plaque.

Pain

An unpleasant physical and emotional experience linked to actual or possible tissue injury. Pain can be short-lived or persistent and is influenced by nerves, inflammation, health, emotions, past experiences, and social circumstances.

Pain Assessment Scales

Tools that help a person describe pain intensity or its effect on daily life. They may use numbers, words, faces, or observation of behavior when self-report is not possible. A score tracks change but does not identify the cause or fully measure suffering.

Painful Bladder Syndrome

Ongoing bladder-related pain, pressure, or discomfort, often with urinary frequency or urgency and no identified infection or other cause. The term overlaps with interstitial cystitis; many clinicians use the combined term interstitial cystitis/bladder pain syndrome.

Painful Intercourse

Pain in the genital or pelvic area before, during, or after sexual activity; medically called dyspareunia. Causes include dryness, infection, inflammation, pelvic-floor spasm, endometriosis, injury, and other gynecologic or urologic conditions.

Painful Menstrual Periods

Painful menstrual periods, or dysmenorrhea, are cramps during menstruation caused by uterine contractions or conditions such as endometriosis or fibroids.

Painful Swallowing

Painful swallowing, or odynophagia, is discomfort when swallowing and may result from infection, inflammation, injury, reflux, or a blockage.

Pain Management

Care that identifies the cause of pain and reduces pain while improving function and quality of life. It may combine medicines, physical treatment, psychological support, procedures, and treatment of the underlying condition, with risks reviewed regularly.

Pain Medicine

The medical specialty concerned with assessment and treatment of acute, chronic, and cancer-related pain. Its scope includes identifying pain mechanisms and functional effects and using approaches such as medicines, procedures, rehabilitation, and psychological care, often with a multidisciplinary team.

Alternate Names:
Algology

Pain Perception

The process by which the nervous system notices possible or actual tissue injury and the brain interprets it as pain. Attention, emotions, past experiences, inflammation, and medicines can change how pain feels.

Painsomnia

An informal term for difficulty falling asleep or staying asleep because of pain. Pain may delay sleep onset or cause awakenings, while disrupted sleep can heighten pain sensitivity and worsen daytime function. "Painsomnia" is not a formal diagnosis; clinical descriptions specify the sleep disturbance and associated pain condition.

Pain Threshold

The minimum intensity of a stimulus that a person perceives as painful; it varies with tissue, context, attention, inflammation, medications, and neurologic state.

Pain Unit

A clinical service specializing in assessment and treatment of acute, chronic, cancer, neuropathic, or procedural pain using medicines, procedures, rehabilitation, and psychological care.

PA/IVS

Alternate name; see *Pulmonary Atresia*.

Palatal Muscle

Muscle of the soft palate that elevates or tenses the palate and helps separate the nasal and oral cavities during swallowing and speech.

Palatal Myoclonus

Repeated, involuntary twitching of the soft palate, sometimes causing a clicking sound in the ear or difficulty speaking and swallowing. It may follow a brainstem injury or occur without an identified cause.

Palate

The roof of the mouth, consisting of a bony hard palate and muscular soft palate.

Palate Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the roof of the mouth. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause a lump, pain, bleeding, loose teeth, difficulty swallowing, or speech changes.

Palatine

Relating to the palate, the roof of the mouth, or the palatine bones. Palatine structures include the tonsils, nerves, and blood vessels of the mouth; problems may include tonsillitis, cleft palate, or infection near a tooth.

Palatine Tonsil

One of two masses of lymphoid tissue at the sides of the throat that help detect inhaled or swallowed pathogens.

Palatorrhaphy

Palatorrhaphy is surgical repair of a cleft or defect of the palate to restore separation between the oral and nasal cavities and improve feeding and speech.

Palatoschisis

A congenital cleft or failure of fusion of the palate, commonly called cleft palate, which may affect feeding, speech, hearing, and dental development.

Alternate Names:
Cleft Palate

Paleness

Unusual lightening of the skin or mucous membranes, which may result from reduced blood flow, anemia, shock, cold, or normal variation.

Paleo Diet

An eating pattern based on foods thought to resemble those available to early humans, such as meat, fish, vegetables, fruits, nuts, and seeds. It excludes or limits grains, legumes, and dairy and may not provide balanced nutrition for everyone.

Pale or Clay-Colored Stools

Light-colored stool caused by reduced bile pigment reaching the intestine, potentially indicating bile-duct obstruction, gallbladder disease, liver disease, or certain transient conditions.

Palindromic Rheumatism

Repeated attacks of joint pain and swelling that begin suddenly and resolve completely within hours or days, leaving no lasting joint damage between attacks. Some people later develop rheumatoid arthritis, especially when specific antibodies are present.

Paliperidone

An antipsychotic medicine used to treat schizophrenia and schizoaffective disorder. It changes the action of certain brain chemicals and is available as tablets or long-acting injections; possible effects include sleepiness, movement problems, weight gain, hormone changes, and heart-rhythm changes.

Palivizumab

A monoclonal antibody that binds the respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) fusion protein. It was given by monthly injection during RSV season to selected high-risk infants and young children to reduce severe RSV disease. In the United States, it was discontinued at the end of 2025 and is no longer routinely recommended; longer-acting RSV antibodies are now used for infant prevention.

Palla Sign

Enlargement of the right descending pulmonary artery on a chest X-ray, described as a possible sign of pulmonary embolism. It is uncommon and nonspecific, so it cannot diagnose or exclude a clot by itself.

Alternate Names:
Palla's Sign; Descending Pulmonary Artery Sign

Pallesthesia

The ability to feel vibration, usually tested with a vibrating tuning fork on the fingers or toes. Reduced vibration sense may result from nerve disease, spinal-cord problems, poor circulation, or other neurologic conditions.

Palliative Care

Care that aims to improve quality of life for people with serious illness and their families by relieving pain and other physical, psychological, social, or spiritual distress. It can be provided at any stage of illness, alongside treatments intended to cure or control disease; it is not limited to hospice or end-of-life care.

Palliative Radiation

Radiation therapy given to relieve symptoms caused by cancer, such as pain, bleeding, obstruction, or pressure from a tumor. It is usually intended to improve comfort or function rather than cure the cancer and may be delivered in a short treatment course.

Palliative Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation for a person with serious or life-limiting illness that focuses on comfort, independence, meaningful activities, and quality of life. It may address weakness, breathlessness, pain, fatigue, movement, communication, swallowing, or daily tasks.

Palliative Surgery

Surgery intended to relieve symptoms, prevent complications, or improve function when the underlying disease may not be curable. It can ease blockage, bleeding, pain, breathing difficulty, or problems caused by advanced cancer.

Palliative Treatment

Treatment intended to relieve symptoms and improve comfort or quality of life rather than cure the underlying disease.

Pallidotomy

A neurosurgical lesioning procedure that destroys a small part of the internal globus pallidus to reduce selected motor complications of Parkinson disease, especially dyskinesia. It is an ablative procedure and does not treat the underlying neurodegeneration.

Pallister-Hall Syndrome

A rare inherited condition that may cause an extra finger or toe, a noncancerous growth near the brain's hormone-control center, and abnormalities of the anus, kidneys, airway, or pituitary hormones.

Pallor

Unusual paleness of skin or mucous membranes, often due to reduced blood flow, anemia, or other illness.

Palm

The inner surface of the hand between the wrist and fingers. It contains thick skin, creases, muscles, nerves, and blood vessels that help with grip, touch, movement, and protection.

Palmar

Relating to the palm or palmar surface of the hand, including the palmar sides of the fingers.

Palmar Erythema

Redness, often on both palms, caused by widening of small blood vessels. It can occur normally or with pregnancy, liver disease, thyroid disease, or other conditions; the cause depends on the clinical context.

Palmar Erythema Of Pregnancy

Redness of both palms that can occur during pregnancy, often because of normal blood-vessel and hormone changes. It is usually harmless and fades after birth; itching or yellowing can accompany liver or bile-duct disease.

Palmar Grasp Reflex

A primitive reflex in which an infant flexes the fingers around an object placed in the palm. It is normally present at birth and gradually diminishes as voluntary grasp develops during infancy.

Palmar Hyperhidrosis

Alternate name; see *Hyperhidrosis*.

Palmar Reflex

Alternate name; see *Palmar Grasp Reflex*.

PALM-COEIN Classification

The FIGO system for classifying causes of abnormal uterine bleeding in nonpregnant reproductive-age patients. PALM denotes structural causes: polyp, adenomyosis, leiomyoma, and malignancy or hyperplasia. COEIN denotes nonstructural causes: coagulopathy, ovulatory dysfunction, endometrial, iatrogenic, and not otherwise classified.

Alternate Names:
FIGO AUB Classification; PALM-COEIN System

Palmitate

Palmitate is the salt or ester form of palmitic acid and participates in fatty-acid metabolism, lipid storage, and protein modification.

Palmitic Acid

A 16-carbon saturated fatty acid common in dietary and stored fats; excess saturated-fat intake can contribute to adverse lipid profiles, although the body also synthesizes it normally.

Palmoplantar Hyperkeratosis

Excessive thickening of the skin on the palms and soles, inherited or acquired, causing calluses, fissures, pain, impaired walking, and sometimes infection.

Palmoplantar Keratoderma (Keratosis Palmaris et Plantaris)

Excessive thickening of the skin on the palms and soles. It may be inherited or acquired and can cause fissures, pain, impaired walking, sweating problems, or secondary infection.

Palmoplantar Pustulosis

A chronic, relapsing inflammatory skin disease with recurrent, sterile pustules on the palms, soles, or both. The pustules often form on reddened, thickened skin, then dry, crust, and peel; itching, pain, or skin cracks may occur. It can occur with or without psoriasis elsewhere on the body.

Alternate Names:
Primary Palmoplantar Pustulosis; Pustulosis Palmaris et Plantaris

Palonosetron Hydrochloride

A long-acting 5-HT3 serotonin-receptor antagonist used to prevent nausea and vomiting caused by chemotherapy, surgery, or selected other treatments.

Palpable

Palpable means detectable by touch during physical examination, such as a mass, enlarged organ, lymph node, pulse, tenderness, or abnormal surface.

Palpable Purpura

Raised red or purple spots caused by bleeding under the skin that do not fade when pressed. It often results from inflammation of small blood vessels, as in leukocytoclastic or IgA vasculitis, but can have other causes.

Palpate

To examine part of the body by feeling it carefully

with the hands. A healthcare professional may assess size, shape, tenderness, warmth, movement, swelling, firmness, pulses, or unusual lumps.

Palpation

Examination by touching the body to assess tenderness, temperature, texture, masses, pulses, organ size, and movement.

Palpebra

The anatomical term for an eyelid. Eyelids protect the eye, spread tears over the cornea, and limit light entry; disorders include drooping, inward or outward turning, inflammation, styes, and blocked oil glands.

Palpebral Conjunctiva

The thin, moist membrane lining the inner surfaces of the eyelids. It joins the membrane covering the front of the eye and helps protect, lubricate, and move tears across the eye's surface.

Palpebral Slant

The upward or downward angle of the line between the inner and outer corners of the eyes. It varies among people and may be one feature considered when assessing a genetic syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Palpebral Fissure Slant

Palpitation

Awareness of the heart beating fast, forcefully, irregularly, or as if it skipped a beat. Causes include stress, stimulants, anemia, thyroid disease, medicines, and abnormal rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Cardiac Palpitations; Palpitations

PALS

Alternate name; see *Pediatric Advanced Life Support*.

Palsy

Weakness or loss of movement in a body part, often affecting muscles supplied by a particular nerve. It may be temporary or lasting and can result from nerve injury, infection, stroke, inflammation, or a problem present from birth.

Palsy Of The Long Thoracic Nerve

Weakness of the nerve that activates a muscle holding the shoulder blade against the ribs. It can cause a winged shoulder blade, difficulty raising the arm, and pain after injury, infection, surgery, or pressure on the nerve.

Pamidronic Acid

An intravenous bisphosphonate that inhibits osteoclast-mediated bone resorption and is used for selected hypercalcemia, bone complications of cancer, and Paget disease.

Pampiniform Plexus

A network of veins in the spermatic cord that drains the testis and helps cool blood entering the testicular artery.

Panacinar Emphysema

A form of emphysema in which air sacs and small airways are damaged throughout affected areas of the lung. It can cause breathlessness and reduced lung function and is strongly associated with severe alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency.

Alternate Names:
Panlobular Emphysema

Pancoast Syndrome

Symptoms caused by a cancer at the top of the lung growing into nearby nerves or other tissues. It may cause severe shoulder or arm pain, hand weakness, numbness, and drooping of one eyelid with a smaller pupil.

Pancoast Tumor

A lung cancer at the top of the lung that can grow into nearby nerves, blood vessels, or the spine. It may cause severe shoulder or arm pain, hand weakness, or drooping of one eyelid.

Pancolitis

Inflammation affecting the entire large intestine. It may result from ulcerative colitis, infection, reduced blood flow, or another inflammatory condition and can cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or bleeding.

Pancreas

An organ behind the stomach that makes digestive juices and hormones. Its digestive enzymes enter the small intestine, while insulin and other hormones help control blood sugar and digestion.

Pancreas Divisum

A congenital difference in which the main pancreatic ducts do not join normally. Most people have no symptoms. It has been proposed as a contributing factor in recurrent pancreatitis, but the association is uncertain and most affected people do not develop pancreatitis.

Pancreas Enzyme

An enzyme produced by the pancreas, such as amylase, lipase, or proteases, that helps digest carbohydrate, fat, or protein in the small intestine.

Pancreas Infection

Infection involving the pancreas or a pancreatic collection, usually occurring with pancreatitis, surgery, trauma, or spread from nearby infection.

Pancreas Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Pancreatitis*.

Pancreas Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the pancreas that may be noncancerous, precancerous, or cancerous. Its effects depend on its location and may include pain, jaundice, digestive problems, or diabetes.

Pancreas Transplant

A procedure that replaces a diseased pancreas with a healthy donor pancreas, usually to restore insulin production in selected people with severe diabetes.

Pancreas Transplantation

Alternate name; see *Pancreas Transplant*.

Pancreatectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the pancreas. It may treat a pancreatic tumor, severe injury, or another serious disease; removal of pancreatic tissue can affect digestion and blood-sugar control.

Pancreatic Abscess

An older term for an infected collection in or near the pancreas, usually related to acute pancreatitis. Current classification describes the collection by its contents, timing, and presence of dead tissue; infection may cause fever, worsening pain, or sepsis.

Pancreatic Adenocarcinoma

The most common cancer of the pancreas, arising from cells in its digestive-juice ducts. It may cause jaundice, abdominal or back pain, weight loss, or no early symptoms; smoking, chronic pancreatitis, diabetes, obesity, and inherited risks can contribute.

Pancreatic Cancer

Cancer that begins in the pancreas, most often in cells lining its digestive-juice ducts. It may cause jaundice, abdominal or back pain, weight loss, or digestive problems, but early cancer may cause no symptoms; treatment depends on type and spread.

Alternate Names:
Pancreatic Carcinoma; Cancer of the Pancreas

Pancreatic Carcinoma

Pancreatic carcinoma is cancer arising in the pancreas, most often from duct cells, and may cause jaundice, pain, weight loss, or digestive problems.

Pancreatic Cysts

Fluid-filled sacs in or around the pancreas. Some follow inflammation or injury, while others are growths that can become cancerous; imaging and sometimes fluid or tissue testing guide follow-up or treatment.

Pancreatic Diseases

Disorders affecting the pancreas's digestive or hormone-producing functions, including inflammation, cysts, tumors, duct blockage, and diabetes-related damage. They may cause abdominal pain, vomiting, weight loss, jaundice, abnormal blood sugar, or poor digestion.

Pancreatic Divisum

Alternate name; see *Pancreas Divisum*.

Pancreatic Duct

The main tube carrying digestive fluid from the pancreas into the first part of the small intestine. It often joins the bile duct before opening into the intestine; blockage can cause pain, jaundice, or pancreatitis.

Pancreatic Ductal Adenocarcinoma

The most common exocrine pancreatic malignancy, arising from ductal epithelium and often presenting late with painless jaundice, weight loss, pain, or pancreatitis. Diagnosis and staging rely on imaging, tissue sampling when needed, and multidisciplinary assessment.

Pancreatic Elastase

A stool test that estimates how well the pancreas makes digestive enzymes. A low result supports pancreatic insufficiency, which can cause greasy stools, weight loss, and vitamin deficiency, but watery stool and other factors can affect interpretation.

Pancreatic Enzyme

A digestive substance made by the pancreas and released into the small intestine. Amylase breaks down starch, lipase breaks down fat, and proteases break down protein; bicarbonate helps neutralize stomach acid.

Pancreatic Exocrine Insufficiency

Alternate name; see *Exocrine Pancreatic Insufficiency*.

Pancreatic Fistula

A pancreatic fistula is an abnormal passage through which pancreatic juice leaks from the pancreas, often after trauma or surgery, causing fluid collections, ascites, or skin drainage.

Pancreatic Hormones

Hormones produced by pancreatic islet cells, including insulin, glucagon, somatostatin, and pancreatic polypeptide, which regulate glucose, digestion, and energy metabolism.

Pancreatic Inflammatory Cysts

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Cysts*.

Pancreatic Insufficiency

Failure of the pancreas to produce or deliver enough digestive enzymes or other secretions for normal digestion and absorption. It may cause greasy stools, diarrhea, bloating, weight loss, or vitamin deficiency; exocrine insufficiency specifically refers to inadequate digestive enzymes.

Pancreatic IPMN

Alternate name; see *Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm*.

Pancreatic IPMN Entry

Alternate name; see *Intraductal Papillary Mucinous Neoplasm*.

Pancreatic Islet

A pancreatic islet is a cluster of endocrine cells that releases hormones such as insulin, glucagon, and somatostatin to regulate blood glucose and digestion.

Pancreatic Juice

Pancreatic juice is an alkaline digestive secretion containing bicarbonate and enzymes such as amylase, lipase, and proteases, delivered into the duodenum.

Pancreatic Mass

A lump or abnormal area seen in the pancreas on

an imaging test. It may be a cyst, inflammation, scar, or tumor; further scans, blood tests, or a tissue sample may be needed to determine its cause.

Pancreatic Necrosis

Death of pancreatic or nearby fatty tissue, usually during severe acute pancreatitis. The dead tissue may remain sterile or become infected, causing fever, worsening pain, sepsis, and organ failure.

Alternate Names:
Necrotizing Pancreatitis; Acute Necrotizing Pancreatitis

Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumor

A neoplasm that develops from the hormone-producing islet cells (islets of Langerhans) in the pancreas. These tumors can be functional, overproducing specific hormones like insulin or gastrin that lead to noticeable symptoms such as severe low blood sugar or recurrent stomach ulcers, or non-functional, producing no excess hormones and often growing silently until they cause abdominal pain, jaundice, or digestive problems.

Alternate Names:
pNET; Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumors; Islet Cell Tumors; Pancreatic Endocrine Neoplasms

Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumors

Plural form; see *Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumor*.

Pancreatic Non-Inflammatory Cysts

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Cysts*.

Pancreaticobiliary Cytology

Cytologic evaluation of pancreatic and biliary lesions, usually from fine-needle aspiration, brushings, or bile-duct sampling. It is used to assess neoplasia, inflammation, and obstructive lesions alongside imaging and histology.

Pancreaticoduodenectomy

Pancreaticoduodenectomy, or the Whipple procedure, removes the head of the pancreas and nearby parts of the digestive tract to treat selected tumors and other serious disease.

Pancreatic Panniculitis

A rare lobular inflammation of subcutaneous fat associated with pancreatic disease, most often acute or chronic pancreatitis or a pancreatic neoplasm. Circulating pancreatic enzymes can cause fat necrosis, producing tender red or violaceous nodules, usually on the legs; lesions may ulcerate and drain oily material. Fat necrosis can also affect joints and bone marrow.

Alternate Names:
Enzymatic Panniculitis; Pancreatic Fat Necrosis

Pancreatic Pseudocyst

A walled-off collection of pancreatic fluid that usually develops after acute or chronic pancreatitis. It has no true cell lining and may cause abdominal pain, vomiting, early fullness, infection, bleeding, or blockage of nearby organs.

Pancreatic Secretion

Release of digestive fluid from the exocrine pancreas into the small intestine. Pancreatic juice contains enzymes that digest carbohydrates, proteins, and fats, together with bicarbonate that helps neutralize stomach acid.

Pancreatic Serous Cystadenoma

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Cysts*.

Pancreatic Surgery

An operation on the pancreas to remove diseased tissue, drain a collection, repair an injury, or treat cancer. The type of surgery depends on the problem and its location.

Pancreatic Trauma

Injury to the pancreas caused by blunt or penetrating trauma. Assessment may require CT, laboratory testing, and observation or intervention according to the injury.

Pancreatitis

Inflammation of the pancreas that may be acute or chronic. Causes include gallstones, alcohol, medicines, metabolic disorders, and other conditions.

Acute disease may cause severe upper-abdominal pain, vomiting, fluid loss, infection, tissue death, or organ failure; chronic disease can permanently scar the pancreas and cause poor digestion, weight loss, or diabetes.

Alternate Names:
Pancreatic Inflammation

Pancreatoblastoma

A rare cancer of the pancreas that occurs mainly in children. It may cause an abdominal lump, pain, vomiting, weight loss, or hormone-related symptoms; diagnosis uses imaging, biopsy, and staging.

Pancreatography

Imaging of the tubes that carry digestive juices from the pancreas, usually after contrast dye is introduced. It can show narrowing, blockage, leaks, stones, or other changes and may be done during ERCP or with MRI; ERCP also carries a risk of pancreatitis.

Pancreazymin

An older name for cholecystokinin, a hormone that stimulates pancreatic enzyme secretion and gallbladder contraction.

Pancrelipase

Pancrelipase is a mixture of pancreatic digestive enzymes used as replacement therapy for exocrine pancreatic insufficiency, including that caused by cystic fibrosis or pancreatic disease.

Pancuronium

A long-acting medicine that temporarily prevents skeletal muscles from contracting during anesthesia or assisted breathing. It causes paralysis but does not relieve pain or cause unconsciousness; its use is accompanied by airway and breathing support.

Pancytopenia

A reduction in red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets at the same time. It can cause tiredness, infections, and bleeding and may result from medicines, infection, immune disease, or a problem in the bone marrow.

PANDAS

A proposed condition in which obsessive-compulsive symptoms or movement tics begin suddenly or worsen after a streptococcal infection in a child. The diagnosis remains debated, and similar symptoms can have neurologic, psychiatric, or infectious causes.

Pandemic

An epidemic that spreads across multiple countries or continents and affects many people. It may occur when an infectious agent spreads widely among populations with limited previous immunity.

Panendoscopy

Examination of several connected areas of the throat and upper swallowing and breathing passages with a viewing instrument, often including the throat, voice box, and swallowing tube. Tissue samples may be taken during the procedure.

Paneth Cell

A cell at the base of a small-intestinal gland that releases substances helping control bacteria and other microbes in the gut. It supports the intestinal lining's normal defense system.

Panhypopituitarism

Failure of the pituitary gland to make most or all of its important hormones. It can cause tiredness, low blood pressure, infertility, growth or thyroid problems, and inability to respond normally to illness; lifelong hormone replacement may be needed.

Panic

Panic is sudden intense fear or distress with autonomic symptoms such as racing heart, sweating, trembling, breathlessness, or a sense of impending danger.

Panic And Anxiety Disorders

Alternate name; see *Anxiety Disorders*.

Panic Attack

A sudden surge of intense fear or discomfort

that usually reaches peak intensity within minutes. Symptoms may include a racing or pounding heart, sweating, trembling, breathlessness, chest pain, nausea, dizziness, tingling, a sense of losing control, or fear of dying.

Panic Attacks And Panic Disorder

Panic attacks are sudden episodes of intense fear; panic disorder involves recurrent attacks and persistent concern about having more.

Panic Disorder

Recurrent unexpected panic attacks followed by at least one month of persistent concern about further attacks or a maladaptive change in behavior related to them. Attacks peak within minutes and may cause a racing heart, breathlessness, trembling, dizziness, or fear of dying.

Panlobular Emphysema

A type of permanent lung damage affecting the whole small air-sac unit, often more severe in the lower lungs. It is strongly associated with alpha-1 antitrypsin deficiency and can cause breathlessness, cough, and reduced exercise ability.

Panmyelopathy

An uncommon, nonstandard term for widespread disease involving the bone marrow or spinal cord; it has no single established meaning. Medical descriptions should specify whether the disorder affects bone-marrow blood-cell production or the spinal cord.

Panniculectomy

Surgical removal of a hanging apron of excess lower-abdominal skin and fat, usually after substantial weight loss; it is distinct from a full abdominoplasty.

Panniculitis

Inflammation of the layer of fat beneath the skin, usually causing tender red or purple lumps, often on the legs. Causes include infection, immune disease, medicines, injury, and pancreatic disease; treatment depends on the cause.

Panniculus

A panniculus is a fold or layer of subcutaneous fatty tissue, especially the lower abdominal apron that may overhang the pubic region.

Pannus

An abnormal layer of inflamed tissue that grows over a joint or the clear front surface of the eye. It can damage cartilage or reduce vision and may occur with rheumatoid arthritis, trachoma, or other chronic inflammation.

Panophthalmitis

Severe infection and inflammation involving the entire eye and its surrounding tissues. It can cause intense pain, redness, swelling, discharge, and major vision loss.

Panoramic Radiograph

An extraoral radiograph displaying both jaws, teeth, temporomandibular regions, and surrounding structures in one image. It is useful for surveying dentition, development, impaction, and gross osseous pathology but has less fine detail than intraoral radiographs.

Panretinal Photocoagulation

A laser treatment that places many small burns in the outer retina to reduce the abnormal blood-vessel growth caused by severe retinal disease, especially diabetic retinopathy. It can preserve central vision but may reduce side or night vision.

Pantothenic Acid

Vitamin B5, needed to help cells make energy and produce fatty acids and certain hormones.

Pantothenic Acid And Biotin

Two B vitamins involved in energy metabolism, fatty-acid synthesis, and other enzyme reactions; deficiency is uncommon but can occur with severe malnutrition, malabsorption, or specific inherited disorders.

Panuveitis

Inflammation affecting all the main internal layers around the eye, including the iris, the gel inside the eye, and the tissues near the retina. It can cause pain, redness, light sensitivity, floaters, and vision loss.

Papain

A protein-breaking enzyme found in papaya latex. It is used in some foods and products, but evidence for many medicinal claims is limited; it can irritate tissues or cause allergic reactions.

Papillary Fibroelastoma

A usually noncancerous, small growth attached to a heart valve. It often causes no symptoms but can release a clot and lead to a stroke or other blockage, especially when it is mobile; treatment depends on its size, location, and risk.

Papillary Muscle

Muscles inside the lower chambers of the heart that connect by thin cords to the heart valves. They tighten when the heart contracts to keep the valves from turning inside out and prevent blood from flowing backward.

Papillary Thyroid Carcinoma

The most common type of thyroid cancer. It often grows slowly and may spread to nearby neck lymph nodes; treatment and outlook depend on the tumor's size, spread, and other features.

Papillectomy

Surgical removal of a papilla or papillary growth, such as a tumor near the bile and pancreatic ducts.

Papilledema

Swelling of the area where the optic nerve enters the eye because pressure inside the skull is raised. It can threaten vision and may result from bleeding, a mass, infection, or other serious illness.

Papilloedema

Swelling of the optic discs caused by raised intracranial pressure.

Papilloma

A usually noncancerous growth from a surface lining, often appearing as a wart, skin tag, or small finger-like projection. Some are linked to human papillomavirus; treatment depends on the site, appearance, and tissue findings.

Papillomatosis

A condition in which multiple papillomas, or wart-like overgrowths of epithelial tissue, develop. Causes and risks vary by body site, virus, inherited condition, or other disease.

Papillomatosis Cutis Lymphostatica

Thick, rough, wart-like skin caused by long-standing swelling from poor lymph or vein drainage, usually in the legs. The skin may become cobblestoned and prone to infection; controlling the swelling and protecting the skin are important.

Papillomavirus

A papillomavirus, especially human papillomavirus, which can cause warts and some anogenital, oropharyngeal, and other cancers.

Papilloma With Atypia / DCIS Pathology

Evaluation of an intraductal papillary breast lesion for fibrovascular cores, epithelial atypia, and ductal carcinoma in situ. The key distinction is between benign papilloma, atypical proliferation, in situ carcinoma, and invasive carcinoma.

Pap Smear

A screening test in which cells are collected from the cervix and examined for early changes that could become cervical cancer or for cancer itself. It may be done alone or with a test for high-risk human papillomavirus (HPV).

Alternate Names:
Pap; Papanicolaou Smear

Pap Test

A screening test for cervical cancer and precancerous changes in which cells are collected from the cervix and examined under a microscope. It may also reveal inflammation or some infections, but an abnormal result does not by itself diagnose cancer.

Papular

A papule: a small, solid, elevated skin lesion <1 cm in diameter (palpable), of various colors and etiologies.

Papular Urticaria

A hypersensitivity reaction to insect bites, especially from fleas, bedbugs, or mosquitoes, causing recurrent intensely itchy papules or small vesicles, often clustered on exposed areas in children. Diagnosis is clinical.

Papule

A solid, raised skin lesion, usually less than 1 cm in diameter. It may be skin-coloured or change colour with inflammation and occurs in conditions such as acne, warts, and psoriasis. Unlike a pustule or vesicle, a papule contains no visible pus or fluid.

Alternate Names:
Papules

Papulonodules

A skin eruption composed of papules and nodules: solid, raised lesions, typically with papules no larger than 1 cm and nodules larger or extending into deeper skin. The term describes lesion morphology, not a specific diagnosis; causes vary with the clinical context.

PAPVR

Alternate name; see *Partial Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Connection*.

Paracentesis

A procedure in which a clinician uses a needle to remove fluid from the abdomen. The fluid may be tested to find its cause or removed to relieve pressure and discomfort.

Paracetamol

Also called acetaminophen, paracetamol reduces pain and fever. Excessive doses can cause serious liver injury, especially with alcohol or other products containing paracetamol.

Alternate Names:
Acetaminophen

Paracetamol Overdose

Exposure to more than a safe amount of paracetamol, also called acetaminophen, can seriously damage the liver even before symptoms appear. The risk depends on the amount, timing, repeated doses, and health of the person; an antidote can reduce the risk of liver failure when given early.

Alternate Names:
Acetaminophen Overdose

Paracetamol Toxicity

Liver injury caused by excessive acetaminophen (paracetamol) exposure. Severe poisoning may cause nausea, abdominal pain, liver failure, or death; an antidote is most effective when given early.

Paracusia

A hearing disturbance in which sounds are perceived unusually, inaccurately, or differently from their actual qualities. It may occur with hearing loss, inner-ear disease, neurological conditions, medicines, or mental health disorders.

Paradichlorobenzene Poisoning

Harm from mothballs or other products containing paradichlorobenzene. It may cause headache, nausea, dizziness, liver injury, or destruction of red blood cells; toxicity depends on the amount and duration of exposure.

Paraesophageal Hernia

A hiatal hernia in which part of the stomach moves through the diaphragm beside the esophagus. It may cause obstruction or strangulation even when reflux is absent.

Paraesthesia

An unusual skin sensation such as tingling, pins and needles, burning, prickling, or numbness. It can result from pressure on a nerve, nerve disease, poor circulation, medicines, vitamin deficiency, or other causes.

Paraffin

A mixture of hydrocarbons used in laboratory tissue processing, topical preparations, and other applications; some forms are flammable.

Paraffin Poisoning

Harm from swallowing or breathing paraffin wax or liquid paraffin. Small swallowed amounts may cause stomach upset, but liquid entering the lungs can cause chemical pneumonia.

Paraganglioma

A rare tumor arising from specialized nerve-related cells outside the adrenal glands. Some release hormones that cause high blood pressure, sweating, headaches, or a fast heartbeat; some occur as part of inherited tumor syndromes.

Paragonimiasis

A parasitic infection caused by lung flukes, usually acquired by eating raw or undercooked freshwater crab or crayfish. It commonly affects the lungs and may cause a long-lasting cough, chest pain, fever, or blood-stained sputum.

Paragraphia

A language problem in which a person writes an unintended word, letter, or symbol instead of the one intended. It may occur with damage to language areas of the brain, such as after a stroke, and is assessed with other speaking, reading, and writing abilities.

Parainfectious

Describing a problem that occurs during or soon after an infection, often because the immune system reacts to the infection rather than because germs directly invade the affected tissue.

Parainfluenza

Parainfluenza viruses are respiratory viruses that commonly cause colds, croup, bronchitis, or pneumonia, especially in children; illness ranges from mild to severe airway disease.

Paraldehyde

An older sedative and anticonvulsant medicine with limited current use.

Paralysis

Loss of voluntary muscle movement in part or all of the body due to nervous-system or muscle disease.

Paralysis Agitans

An older name for Parkinson disease, characterized by tremor, rigidity, and bradykinesia.

Paralytic Ileus

A temporary slowdown or stop in the bowel's movement, even though there is no physical blockage. It can make the belly swell and cause pain, nausea, vomiting, or constipation. It may happen after surgery or with illness or some medicines.

Paramedical

Relating to healthcare professionals or services that support medical practice, such as physiotherapy, radiography, or emergency medical care.

Parametritis

Inflammation or infection of the connective tissue beside the uterus, often associated with pelvic infection or occurring after childbirth, miscarriage, or surgery. It may cause pelvic pain, fever, tenderness, or abnormal discharge.

Paramnesia

A memory disturbance involving false, distorted, or inaccurately familiar recollections.

Paramyotonia Congenita

An inherited skeletal-muscle sodium-channel disorder, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *SCN4A*. Cold exposure and repeated muscle contrac-

tions can cause paradoxically worsening stiffness, often affecting the face, eyelids, neck, or hands; episodes may be followed by temporary weakness.

Alternate Names:
Eulenburg Disease; Paramyotonia Congenita of Eulenburg

Paranasal Sinuses

Air-filled spaces in the bones around the nose that connect with the nasal passages. Their lining produces mucus, which drains into the nose; inflammation or blockage can cause facial pressure, congestion, and pain.

Paraneoplastic Autonomic Neuropathy

Autoimmune injury to autonomic nerves associated with cancer, causing problems such as abnormal blood-pressure control, sweating, heart-rate variability, gastrointestinal motility, bladder function, or sexual function. It may accompany broader paraneoplastic neurologic syndromes.

Paraneoplastic Cerebellar Degeneration

A rare disorder in which an immune response linked to cancer damages the cerebellum, the brain area that coordinates movement. It can cause rapidly worsening poor balance, uncoordinated movement, slurred speech, or abnormal eye movements and may appear before the cancer is found. Specific antibodies can help guide evaluation.

Alternate Names:
PCD; Subacute Cerebellar Degeneration

Paraneoplastic Disorder

A health problem caused indirectly by cancer rather than by the tumor invading or spreading to the affected organ. Tumors may release hormones or trigger immune reactions that affect the nerves, skin, blood, joints, or other distant organs.

Paraneoplastic Encephalomyelitis

An immune-mediated disorder affecting multiple regions of the central or peripheral nervous system in association with cancer, without direct tumor invasion or metastasis. Manifestations vary with the neural structures involved and may include cognitive, sensory, motor, autonomic, or cerebellar dysfunction.

Paraneoplastic Endocrine Syndromes

Hormonal disorders caused by a cancer or by the body's response to it rather than by direct tumor growth in an endocrine gland. Examples include inappropriate antidiuretic hormone secretion, ectopic adrenocorticotropic hormone production, and hypercalcemia caused by tumor-related factors.

Paraneoplastic Neurological Disorder

Alternate name; see *Paraneoplastic Syndromes Of The Nervous System*.

Paraneoplastic Neurological Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Paraneoplastic Syndromes Of The Nervous System*.

Paraneoplastic Neurologic Syndrome

A rare group of nervous system disorders that occur when an underlying cancer triggers an abnormal autoimmune response. The immune system, in its effort to fight the cancer, mistakenly produces antibodies that attack healthy nerve tissues in the brain, spinal cord, or peripheral nerves. Symptoms vary depending on the nerves involved but can include difficulty walking, loss of balance, muscle weakness, confusion, or sensory disturbances, often appearing months before the underlying tumor is detected.

Alternate Names:
Paraneoplastic Neurologic Syndromes; Paraneoplastic Neurological Disorder; PNS

Paraneoplastic Neurologic Syndromes

Plural form; see *Paraneoplastic Neurologic Syndrome*.

Paraneoplastic Pemphigus

A rare, often severe autoimmune blistering disease associated with an underlying tumor, especially a lymphoid cancer. It causes painful mouth sores and skin lesions and may affect the lungs or other mucous membranes.

Paraneoplastic Syndrome

A group of clinical effects caused by tumor-produced substances or an immune response to cancer, rather than by direct tumor invasion, compression, or metastasis. Manifestations may involve endocrine, neurologic, dermatologic, hematologic, renal, or rheumatologic systems.

Paraneoplastic Syndromes Of The Nervous System

Nervous-system problems caused by an immune reaction to a cancer rather than by the cancer growing into the nerves or brain. They may cause weakness, poor balance, seizures, memory change, or abnormal sensation.

Alternate Names:
Paraneoplastic Neurological Syndromes; PNS

Paranoia

A thought process characterized by excessive or irrational suspiciousness and distrust of others, often manifesting as delusions of persecution, reference, or grandeur.

Paranoid

Characterized by persistent or excessive suspicion and distrust, often involving beliefs that others intend harm. Severe or fixed beliefs may occur in a psychotic disorder.

Paranoid Ideation

Suspicious or persecutory thoughts that other people intend harm, deceive, monitor, or plot against the person. The significance depends on the degree of conviction, distress, functional effect, and associated symptoms.

Paranoid Personality Disorder

A longstanding pattern of distrust and suspiciousness in which other people's motives are interpreted as threatening or deceitful.

Paranoid Psychosis

An older term for psychosis dominated by delusions of persecution, reference, or grandeur.

Paraparesis

Weakness in both legs caused by disease affecting the spinal cord, brain, nerves, or muscles.

Paraphasia

An unintended substitution, omission, or distortion of a sound or word during speech. It commonly occurs with aphasia after brain injury or stroke and may affect naming, conversation, reading, or writing.

Paraphilia

A persistent and intense sexual interest involving atypical objects, situations, or activities. A paraphilia by itself is not a mental disorder. It becomes a paraphilic disorder when it causes significant personal distress or problems in daily life, apart from distress caused only by social disapproval, or when acting on it involves harm, risk of harm, or people who do not or cannot consent.

Paraphilic Disorder

A psychiatric disorder in which recurrent, intense, sexually arousing fantasies, urges, or behaviors (paraphilias) cause clinically significant distress or impairment in social, occupational, or other important areas of functioning, or involve distress, injury, or non-consenting individuals. Distinct from non-disordered paraphilic interests, specific DSM-5 diagnostic categories include exhibitionistic, voyeuristic, frotteuristic, sexual masochism, sexual sadism, pedophilic, fetishistic, and transvestic disorders. Management incorporates cognitive-behavioral psychotherapy and pharmacological interventions (e.g., SSRIs or antiandrogens) where clinically indicated.

Alternate Names:
Paraphilic Disorders

Paraphilic Disorders

Plural form; see *Paraphilic Disorder*.

Paraphimosis

A retracted foreskin trapped behind the head of the penis. The tight band can cause swelling and cut off blood flow if it is not released.

Paraplegia

Paralysis or severe weakness of both legs, usually caused by spinal-cord or other neurologic disease.

Parapneumonic Effusion

Pleural fluid that develops in association with pneumonia. It may be uncomplicated, complicated by bacterial invasion or loculation, or progress to empyema, which is pus in the pleural space.

Parapneumonic Pleural Effusion

See *Parapneumonic Effusion*.

Parapneumonic Pleural Effusions and Empyema Thoracis

Pleural fluid associated with pneumonia is a parapneumonic effusion; empyema is frank pus in the pleural space. A complicated parapneumonic effusion has evidence of pleural-space infection, such as positive microbiology, low pH, or loculation, but is not necessarily purulent.

Parapsoriasis

A group of chronic scaly patches or thin plaques that resemble psoriasis but have different causes and risks. Some forms remain stable, while large-plaque disease can rarely evolve into cutaneous T-cell lymphoma.

Paraquat

A highly toxic herbicide. Ingestion can cause injury to the mouth and gastrointestinal tract, kidney failure, and delayed lung injury; severe poisoning has a high risk of death.

Paraquat Poisoning

A medical emergency caused by swallowing or significant exposure to the herbicide paraquat. It can burn the mouth and digestive tract and later cause lung, kidney, or liver failure.

Paraseptal Emphysema

A form of emphysema affecting air sacs near the outer surface of the lung. It may cause few symptoms but can form fragile air pockets that rupture and cause a collapsed lung.

Parasite

An organism that lives on or inside another organism, called the host, and obtains food or shelter from it. Parasites may cause disease in the skin, intestine, blood, or organs.

Parasitemia

The presence and amount of parasites in the bloodstream. It is especially used for malaria and some other blood infections; a higher amount may indicate more severe disease, but interpretation depends on the parasite and the person's symptoms.

Parasitic

Parasitic means relating to an organism that lives in or on a host and obtains nutrients at the host's expense, sometimes causing disease.

Parasitic Infection

Illness caused by a parasite living in or on a person. Parasites include protozoa, helminths, and ectoparasites such as lice or mites; manifestations and transmission vary by organism.

Alternate Names:
Parasitic Infections; Parasitic Disease; Parasitosis

Parasitic Worm

A worm that lives in or on a host and uses the host for nourishment. Human infections may affect the intestine, blood, lymph system, lungs, liver, skin, or other tissues and can cause anemia, pain, or organ damage.

Parasitology

The study of parasites and the diseases they cause, including those caused by protozoa, worms, and external parasites.

Parasitosis

Infestation or infection by a parasite; the term may describe a confirmed parasitic disease or, in delusional parasitosis, a fixed false belief of infestation without evidence.

Parasomnia

A category of sleep disorders characterized by abnormal behavioral, experiential, or physiological events occurring during entry into sleep, within specific sleep stages, or during sleep-to-wake transitions. Classified into non-rapid eye movement (NREM) parasomnias (e.g., confusional arousals, sleepwalking, sleep terrors), rapid eye movement (REM) parasomnias (e.g., REM sleep behavior disorder, nightmare disorder), and other types (e.g., sleep-related hallucinations). Diagnosis is aided by nocturnal polysomnography, and management focuses on environmental safety, sleep hygiene, and pharmacotherapy when indicated.

Alternate Names:
Parasomnias

Parasomnias

Plural form; see *Parasomnia*.

Parasternal Heave

A palpable lifting or thrusting sensation felt over the left parasternal border during systole, examined using the heel of the examiner's hand. It is a sign of right ventricular hypertrophy or right ventricular volume overload, commonly seen in severe pulmonary hypertension or congenital heart defects.

Parasuicide

An older term for a nonfatal act of intentional self-injury or self-poisoning, used variably for acts with or without suicidal intent. Current descriptions generally use *self-harm* and state whether there was intent to die; see *Suicide Attempt*.

Parasympathetic Nervous System

The part of the automatic nervous system that supports resting functions such as digestion, saliva, urination, and slowing the heartbeat. It also helps the body conserve energy and recover after activity.

Parathyroid

One of the usually four small glands behind the thyroid gland. They release parathyroid hormone, which helps keep calcium and phosphate levels balanced in the blood and bones.

Parathyroid Adenoma

A usually noncancerous growth in one of the small glands behind the thyroid. It may release too much parathyroid hormone, raising the calcium level in the blood.

Parathyroid Cancer

Parathyroid cancer is a rare malignant tumor of the parathyroid gland that often causes excessive parathyroid hormone and high blood calcium.

Parathyroid Carcinoma

A rare malignant tumor of the parathyroid gland that commonly causes excessive parathyroid-hormone secretion, hypercalcemia, kidney stones, bone disease, or related symptoms.

Parathyroid Crisis

A life-threatening rise in blood calcium caused by severe overactivity of the parathyroid glands. It may cause extreme thirst, vomiting, constipation, confusion, weakness, abnormal heart rhythm, kidney injury, or coma.

Parathyroidectomy

Surgery to remove one or more overactive parathyroid glands. It may treat primary or kidney-related hyperparathyroidism when hormone excess causes high calcium, kidney stones, bone disease, or other complications; blood calcium can fall after surgery.

Parathyroid Gland

One of usually four small, bean-sized endocrine glands located on the posterior surface of the thyroid gland. Composed primarily of chief cells and oxyphil cells, the glands synthesize and secrete parathyroid hormone (PTH) in response to hypocalcemia, acting on bone (stimulating osteoclastic resorption), the kidneys (increasing calcium reabsorption and activating 1,25-dihydroxyvitamin D), and the intestines to tightly maintain calcium and phosphate homeostasis.

Alternate Names:
Parathyroid Glands

Parathyroid Gland Removal

Surgery to remove one or more overactive parathyroid glands, usually for persistent high blood calcium. It can improve symptoms and protect bones or kidneys; low calcium, bleeding, voice-nerve injury, or persistent disease may occur.

Parathyroid Glands

Plural form; see *Parathyroid Gland*.

Parathyroid Hormone

A hormone that regulates calcium and phosphate levels in the blood and supports bone remodeling.

Parathyroid Hormone Blood Test

A blood test measuring parathyroid hormone, interpreted with calcium, phosphate, vitamin D, and kidney function to evaluate parathyroid and calcium disorders.

Parathyroid Hormone Physiology

When blood calcium falls, the parathyroid glands release more parathyroid hormone. The hormone acts on bone and kidneys and increases active vitamin D, helping raise calcium and maintain the balance needed for nerves, muscles, and bones.

Parathyroid Hormone-Related Protein Blood Test

A blood test measuring parathyroid hormone-related protein, used mainly to evaluate humoral hypercalcemia of malignancy and selected disorders of calcium regulation.

Parathyroid Hormone Test

A blood test measuring intact parathyroid hormone (PTH) to investigate abnormal calcium levels and parathyroid gland function; see *Parathyroid Hormone* and *Parathyroid Hormone Blood Test*.

Parathyroid Hyperplasia

Enlargement of one or more small glands behind the thyroid, causing them to release too much parathyroid hormone. This can raise blood calcium and may occur with kidney disease or inherited multiple-gland disorders.

Parathyroid Surgery

Operations on the parathyroid glands, usually performed for selected cases of primary or secondary hyperparathyroidism. The decision depends on symptoms, calcium levels, kidney involvement, bone disease, overall health, and current clinical guidance.

Paratubal Cyst

A usually noncancerous, fluid-filled sac near a fallopian tube or ovary, separate from the ovary. It often causes no symptoms, but a larger cyst may cause pain or twist with the tube.

Alternate Names:
Paratubal Cysts; Paraovarian Cyst; Paraovarian Cysts; Parovarian Cyst

Paratyphoid Fever

An enteric fever caused by *Salmonella enterica* serovars Paratyphi A, B, or C, usually acquired through contaminated food or water. It can cause sustained fever, headache, weakness, and abdominal symptoms and can be severe.

Parechovirus

A group of viruses that commonly cause mild respiratory or gastrointestinal illness but can cause severe sepsis-like illness, meningitis, or encephalitis in newborns and young infants.

Parenchyma

The working tissue of an organ, distinguished from its supporting framework, blood vessels, and connective tissue. For example, lung parenchyma performs gas exchange, while liver parenchyma processes nutrients and harmful substances.

Parenchymal

Parenchymal means relating to the functional cells of an organ, distinguished from its supporting connective tissue, vessels, and framework.

Parenteral

Parenteral means delivered by a route other than

the gastrointestinal tract, commonly by injection or infusion such as intravenous, intramuscular, or subcutaneous administration.

Parenteral Nutrition

Nutrition given through a vein when the digestive tract cannot safely absorb enough nutrients. The solution can contain water, glucose, amino acids, fats, vitamins, and minerals. It can cause bloodstream infection, liver problems, or abnormal blood sugar and salts, so it requires monitoring.

Parenting

The care, protection, guidance, and support provided to a child. It includes meeting basic needs, setting safe limits, and supporting development.

Paresis

Partial weakness or incomplete paralysis of voluntary muscles. It may affect one limb, one side of the body, both legs, or all four limbs, depending on the nerves, brain, or spinal cord involved.

Paresthesia

An unusual sensation such as tingling, prickling, burning, pins and needles, or numbness. Brief symptoms often follow pressure on a nerve, while persistent or spreading symptoms can occur with nerve or circulation disorders.

Paresthesia (Pins and Needles)

Alternate name; see *Paresthesia*.

Paricalcitol

Paricalcitol is a vitamin-D receptor activator used to reduce secondary hyperparathyroidism in selected chronic kidney disease, with monitoring for calcium and phosphate changes.

Parietal

Relating to a wall of a body cavity or to the parietal bone or lobe of the skull and brain.

Parietal Bone

One of two broad bones forming much of the skull's sides and roof. They protect the brain, meet along the top midline, and connect with several neighboring skull bones.

Parietal Cell Antibodies

Antibodies directed against proteins in the stomach's parietal cells. They can support evaluation for autoimmune gastritis or pernicious anemia, but a positive result alone does not establish either diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
PCA; Anti-Parietal Cell Antibodies

Parietal Lobe

A part of the brain that processes touch, pain, temperature, body position, and spatial awareness. Damage may cause numbness, difficulty recognizing objects by touch, poor coordination, or trouble understanding where parts of the body are.

Parietal Pericardium

The outer serous layer of the pericardium that lines the inner surface of the fibrous sac surrounding the heart.

Parietal Pleura

The pleural layer lining the chest wall, diaphragm, and mediastinum; it is sensitive to pain when inflamed.

Parinaud Oculoglandular Syndrome

Conjunctivitis with nearby lymph-node swelling, usually caused by infections such as Bartonella, tularemia, or certain viruses.

Parinaud Syndrome

A disorder caused by dysfunction of the dorsal midbrain, characterized by impaired upward gaze, abnormal pupil responses, and convergence-retraction eye movements. Causes include tumors, stroke, multiple sclerosis, and hydrocephalus.

Paris System For Reporting Urinary Cytology

A standardized framework for urinary cytology that

emphasizes detection of high-grade urothelial carcinoma and uses defined categories to improve diagnostic consistency and clinical communication.

Parity

The number of pregnancies that reached the gestational-age threshold used to count a birth, regardless of whether the infant was born alive or stillborn. The threshold varies by clinical convention; parity differs from gravidity, which counts all pregnancies.

Park-Bench Position

A modified lateral position in which the upper body is partly rotated toward prone; it is used for selected posterior brain and neck procedures.

Parkinson Disease

Alternate spelling; see *Parkinson's Disease*.

Parkinsonian Gait

A walking pattern that may occur in Parkinson disease, with short shuffling steps and reduced arm swing. A stooped posture, freezing, or increasingly rapid short steps (festination) may also occur, but features vary and often change as the disease progresses.

Parkinsonism

A group of movement problems involving slowness, stiffness, shaking, or balance difficulty. Parkinson disease is one cause, but medicines, other brain disorders, and several less common conditions can produce similar symptoms.

Parkinson's Disease

A progressive neurodegenerative movement disorder caused by the gradual loss of dopamine-producing nerve cells in a deep region of the brain called the substantia nigra. Because dopamine is essential for smooth, coordinated muscle movement, its deficiency leads to hallmark motor symptoms: tremors (often starting in one hand as a rhythmic shaking at rest), muscle stiffness or rigidity, slowness of movement (bradykinesia), and balance or posture difficulties. Non-motor symptoms such as loss of smell, sleep disturbances, constipation, and mood changes often develop before or alongside motor signs.

Alternate Names:
Idiopathic Parkinsonism; Paralysis Agitans; PD; Parkinson Disease

Parkinson's Disease Center

Alternate name; see *Parkinson's Disease*.

P Arm Of A Chromosome

The shorter arm of a chromosome, labeled p, opposite the longer q arm. A genetic report may use this label to show where a gene change or missing or extra DNA segment is located.

Paromomycin

Paromomycin is an aminoglycoside antibiotic used mainly in the intestine for selected parasitic infections and sometimes for other infections under specialist care.

Paronychia

Inflammation of the nail fold, often with infection, causing pain, redness, and swelling beside a fingernail or toenail. Acute cases may form pus after a break in the skin; chronic cases are often related to repeated moisture or irritant exposure.

Parosteal Osteosarcoma

Parosteal osteosarcoma is a usually lower-grade bone cancer that grows on the outer surface of a bone, often near the back of the thigh.

Parotidectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of a parotid salivary gland, usually because of a tumor. Possible complications include facial-nerve weakness, bleeding, infection, saliva leakage, numbness, or sweating while eating.

Parotid Gland

The largest major saliva-producing gland, located in front of and below each ear. It releases saliva into the mouth near the upper back teeth and can

become swollen from infection, blockage, inflammation, or a tumor.

Parotid Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in a parotid salivary gland in front of or below the ear. Most are noncancerous, but some are cancerous; a painless lump, facial weakness, pain, or rapid growth may occur.

Parotid Swelling

Swelling of one or both parotid glands, the large saliva-producing glands in front of and below the ears. Causes include infection, a blocked saliva duct, inflammation, or a growth.

Parotid Tumor

An abnormal neoplasm arising within the parotid salivary gland, the largest of the major salivary glands. Approximately 75–80% of parotid neoplasms are benign, most frequently pleomorphic adenoma (benign mixed tumor) and Warthin tumor (papillary cystadenoma lymphomatosum). Malignant parotid tumors include mucoepidermoid carcinoma, adenoid cystic carcinoma, and acinic cell carcinoma, which may manifest as a rapid-growing mass, local pain, skin fixation, or facial nerve (cranial nerve VII) paralysis. Diagnostic evaluation involves fine-needle aspiration biopsy and MRI or CT, followed by superficial or total parotidectomy with facial nerve preservation.

Alternate Names:
Parotid Tumors; Parotid Neoplasm

Parotid Tumors

Plural form; see *Parotid Tumor*.

Parotitis

Inflammation or infection of one or both parotid salivary glands, which lie in front of and below the ears. It can cause painful swelling, fever, dry mouth, or pus near the upper back teeth. Causes include viruses such as mumps, bacteria, blocked ducts, dehydration, and autoimmune disease.

Paroxetine Hydrochloride

Paroxetine hydrochloride is an SSRI antidepressant used for depression and several anxiety-related disorders; it can cause sexual side effects and withdrawal symptoms if stopped abruptly.

Paroxysm

A sudden, often brief attack or burst of symptoms or body activity that may recur. Examples include an episode of pain, coughing, rapid heartbeat, seizure, or involuntary movement; the cause depends on the symptom.

Paroxysmal Atrial Fibrillation

A clinical subtype of atrial fibrillation in which recurrent, uncoordinated atrial tachyarrhythmias terminate spontaneously or with pharmacological/electrical intervention within seven days of onset (usually within 48 hours).

Alternate Names:
PAF

Paroxysmal Atrial Tachycardia

Sudden episodes of rapid, regular atrial rhythm that start and stop abruptly, often producing palpitations, lightheadedness, chest discomfort, or shortness of breath.

Paroxysmal Cold Hemoglobinuria

A rare immune disorder in which cold temperatures trigger destruction of red blood cells when the blood warms again. It can cause sudden anemia, fever, back pain, jaundice, or dark urine, often after an infection.

Paroxysmal Hemicrania

A rare headache disorder causing repeated attacks of severe one-sided pain, usually around the eye or temple. Attacks last 2 to 30 minutes and may occur many times a day, with tearing, a red eye, or a blocked or runny nose on the painful side. Attacks stop with indomethacin, a key feature used to distinguish this disorder.

Paroxysmal Nocturnal Dyspnea

Sudden breathlessness that wakes a person after they have been asleep for a while, often improving after sitting or standing. It commonly occurs

with heart failure but may have other heart or lung causes.

Paroxysmal Nocturnal Haemoglobinuria

Alternate spelling; see *Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria*.

Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria

A rare acquired disorder of blood-forming stem cells. Red blood cells lack protective proteins and are destroyed by the complement system, which can cause anemia, dark urine, blood clots, low blood counts, or kidney injury.

Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria (PNH)

Alternate name; see *Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria*.

Paroxysmal Positional Nystagmus

Involuntary, rhythmic eye movements triggered by a change in head position. It may accompany benign paroxysmal positional vertigo or arise from another vestibular or neurologic disorder; persistent or atypical nystagmus can have central neurologic causes.

Paroxysmal Supraventricular Tachycardia

Repeated episodes of a very fast, usually regular heartbeat that start and stop suddenly and begin in the upper chambers or connecting electrical tissues of the heart. It may cause pounding heartbeat, dizziness, chest discomfort, breathlessness, or fainting.

Alternate Names:
PSVT

Pars

A part or portion of an anatomical structure, used in names such as pars interarticularis.

Pars Compacta

A dopamine-producing part of the substantia nigra, a movement-control area deep in the brain. Loss of these nerve cells contributes to the slowness, stiffness, and tremor of Parkinson disease.

Parsonage-Turner Syndrome

An acute neuro-inflammatory disorder affecting the brachial plexus, typically presenting with the abrupt onset of excruciating, unremitting, burning shoulder and periscapular pain, followed days to weeks later by patchy multifocal muscle weakness, flaccid paresis, and rapid denervation atrophy of the shoulder girdle and arm muscles. Often triggered by prior viral infection, vaccination, trauma, or surgical stress.

Alternate Names:
Neuralgic Amyotrophy; Acute Brachial Radiculitis; Brachial Plexitis

Pars Planitis

A form of inflammation inside the eye, near the edge of the retina. It may cause floaters, blurred vision, and swelling or other retinal complications and is treated according to its severity and cause.

Partial

Partial means incomplete or involving only a portion, such as partial loss, partial response, partial thickness, or partial seizure; the specific meaning depends on context.

Partial Agonist

A medicine that attaches to a cell receptor and activates it, but produces a smaller effect than a full activator even when all available receptors are occupied. It can reduce the effect of a stronger activator at the same receptor.

Partial Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Connection

A congenital cardiovascular malformation in which one or more (but not all) pulmonary veins drain into the systemic venous circulation (e.g., superior vena cava, right atrium, or coronary sinus) instead of the left atrium, commonly associated with a sinus venosus atrial septal defect. It produces a left-to-right shunt whose physiological severity depends on the volume of anomalous pulmonary venous flow.

Alternate Names:

PAPVC; Partial Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Return; PAPVR

Partial Breast Brachytherapy

Radiation treatment placed inside or next to the area where a breast cancer was removed, usually after breast-conserving surgery. It treats selected early cancers over a shorter course but may cause skin changes, breast firmness, infection, or delayed healing.

Partial Cystectomy

Surgery to remove part of the urinary bladder, usually for a tumor or localized disease while leaving the rest of the bladder in place. Urinary or surgical complications can occur, and the remaining bladder can develop recurrent disease.

Partial Denture

A removable replacement for some missing teeth, supported by remaining teeth, gums, or both. It may use metal or plastic and can improve chewing, speech, appearance, and tooth stability.

Partial Hysterectomy

A common but imprecise term usually referring to supracervical or subtotal hysterectomy, in which the uterine body is removed while the cervix remains. The fallopian tubes and ovaries may or may not be removed separately.

Partial Knee Replacement

Surgery replacing only the damaged compartment of the knee with an artificial surface while preserving healthy bone, ligaments, and cartilage. It may relieve pain from localized arthritis; infection, clots, stiffness, loosening, or later arthritis elsewhere can occur.

Partial Lipodystrophy

A form of lipodystrophy involving selective deficiency or loss of body fat in specific regions rather than throughout the body. It may be inherited or acquired, and depending on the subtype and extent, can be associated with insulin resistance, diabetes, high triglycerides, or fatty liver.

Partial Nephrectomy

Partial nephrectomy removes a diseased part of a kidney while preserving the remaining healthy tissue.

Partial Remission

A reduction in signs, symptoms, or measurable disease burden that does not meet criteria for complete remission; the definition depends on the disease and response criteria used.

Partial Response

A measurable improvement after treatment in which a tumor or other disease becomes smaller or less active but does not disappear completely. The exact amount of improvement required is defined by the cancer type, test method, or study criteria.

Partial Seizure

Obsolete term for a *focal seizure*, which begins in networks limited to one cerebral hemisphere. Awareness may be preserved or impaired, and manifestations depend on the networks involved.

Partial Thromboplastin Time

A blood test measuring how long a clot takes to form through several clotting pathways. It helps investigate unusual bleeding and monitor unfractionated heparin; abnormal results may reflect a clotting-factor problem, medicine effect, or another illness.

Partial Volume Artifact

An imaging effect that occurs when one image element contains more than one tissue or structure, blending their signals and blurring boundaries.

Alternate Names:
Partial-Volume Effect

Partial-Volume Effect

Alternate name; see *Partial Volume Artifact*.

Participation

A person's involvement in life situations and activities, a central concept in rehabilitation and the

International Classification of Functioning that extends beyond impairment alone.

Particle Size

Particle size is the diameter or size distribution of particles in a powder, suspension, aerosol, or formulation, influencing dissolution, absorption, stability, and delivery.

Particulate Matter

Small solid or liquid particles suspended in air. Fine particles can penetrate the lungs and increase cardiovascular and respiratory risk.

Partogram

A graphic record of cervical change, fetal descent, contractions, and maternal or fetal observations during labor. It can support communication and recognition of abnormal progress; interpretation depends on current labor guidance and the overall clinical situation.

Alternate Names:
Labor Progress Chart; Partographic Curve

Parturition

The process of childbirth, including cervical ripening, labor contractions, delivery of the fetus, and expulsion of the placenta.

Paruresis

Difficulty urinating in the presence of other people or in public places, often called shy bladder syndrome. It is related to anxiety and can improve with behavioral therapy and gradual exposure.

Alternate Names:
Shy Bladder Syndrome

Parvimonas Micra

An anaerobic gram-positive bacterium found in the mouth and gastrointestinal tract that can cause dental, bone, joint, or bloodstream infections.

Parvoviridae

A family of very small DNA viruses; human parvovirus B19 can cause fifth disease, anemia, or fetal complications.

Parvovirus

A small DNA virus; parvovirus B19 is the main human pathogen and can cause rash, joint symptoms, or red-cell aplasia.

Parvovirus B19

A human virus spread mainly through respiratory droplets. It commonly causes a mild rash illness in children, but can cause joint pain or severe anemia and may harm a fetus during pregnancy.

Parvovirus B19 Infection

An infection that may cause fever, a slapped-cheek rash, joint pain, or temporary reduction in red-blood-cell production. It can be serious in people with certain blood disorders or weakened immunity and can affect pregnancy after significant exposure.

Parvovirus Infection

An infection caused by parvovirus B19 that commonly causes mild fever and rash but may be serious in some people.

Alternate Names:
Fifth Disease; Erythema Infectiosum; Slapped Cheek Disease

Passive Exercise

Movement of a person's joint or limb by another person, a machine, or gravity without active muscle effort from the patient. It can maintain flexibility and reduce stiffness when illness or weakness limits movement, but forceful movement can injure tissues.

Passive Heat Therapy

Use of external heat, such as warm packs, baths, or saunas, to relax muscles and temporarily reduce pain or stiffness. Excessive heat can cause burns, dehydration, or fainting.

Passive Immunity

Protection produced by transferred antibodies rather than by the person's own immune response, such as maternal antibodies or immunoglobulin

treatment.

Passive Immunization

Protection produced by giving preformed antibodies, such as immunoglobulin or antivenom, which acts quickly but is temporary because the recipient does not generate durable immune memory.

Passive Smoking

Breathing smoke from another person's tobacco or nicotine product. Secondhand smoke increases the risk of respiratory disease, heart disease, stroke, and lung cancer and is especially harmful to children and during pregnancy.

Pasteurella

A genus of bacteria carried by animals that can cause wound infections after bites and other human disease.

Pasteurella Aerogenes

Pasteurella aerogenes is a rare Pasteurella species; its recovery from a clinical sample should be interpreted with the source and evidence of infection.

Pasteurella Canis

Pasteurella canis is a bacterium found in dogs and cats that can cause wound or soft-tissue infection after an animal bite.

Pasteurellaceae

Pasteurellaceae is a family of bacteria that includes Pasteurella and related animal-associated organisms capable of causing bite-wound and respiratory infections.

Pasteurella Multocida

A bacterium commonly carried by animals that can cause wound infections after bites or scratches and, less often, respiratory or bloodstream infection.

Pasteurellosis

Infection caused by Pasteurella bacteria, commonly introduced through animal bites or scratches and causing cellulitis, abscesses, or occasionally invasive disease.

Pasteurization

A heat treatment reducing microbial load in liquids by heating below boiling point to inactivate vegetative pathogens and spoilage organisms while preserving quality.

Pastia Lines

Darker red lines that appear in skin creases during some rashes, especially scarlet fever. They support the diagnosis when other signs fit but are not specific by themselves.

Alternate Names:
Pastia's Sign; Pastia Lines of Scarlet Fever

Patau's Syndrome

A congenital disorder caused by an extra copy of chromosome 13. It can cause severe developmental problems, brain and heart defects, cleft lip or palate, and other organ abnormalities.

Patau Syndrome

A genetic condition caused by an extra copy of chromosome 13. It can cause severe problems involving brain development, growth, the eyes, heart, kidneys, hands or feet, and the lip or palate. Many affected pregnancies end before birth, and surviving infants often have complex medical needs.

Patau Syndrome (Trisomy 13)

Alternate name; see *Patau Syndrome*.

Patch

A flat, circumscribed area of altered skin or mucous membrane color larger than 1.0 cm in diameter, without elevation, depression, or textural change relative to surrounding tissue. It represents the larger counterpart of a macule and can arise from vascular, pigmentary (e.g., vitiligo, melasma, café-au-lait macules), inflammatory, or neoplastic dermatologic processes.

Alternate Names:
Patches

Patches

Plural form; see *Patch*.

Patch Graft

A piece of natural or synthetic material sewn onto a blood vessel to widen or repair it during patch angioplasty. Materials may include a patient's tissue, bovine pericardium, or synthetic PTFE.

Patch Test

A skin test used to identify delayed allergic contact reactions to substances applied under adhesive patches.

Patch Testing

Patch testing helps identify substances that cause allergic contact dermatitis. Small amounts of suspected allergens are placed on the skin, usually on the back, under patches; a clinician checks for delayed reactions over the following days. The allergens and timing vary by test series and clinical need.

Patch Tonsil

A white or yellow spot or coating on a tonsil. It can occur with an infection, but its appearance alone cannot show whether the cause is bacterial or viral; a tonsil stone can also look like a patch.

Patchy Skin Color

Areas of skin that are lighter, darker, redder, or otherwise different in color from the surrounding skin. Causes include vitiligo, birthmarks, inflammation, infection, sun exposure, injury, and changes in blood flow; appearance and evolution vary with the cause.

Patella

The largest sesamoid bone in the human body, embedded within the quadriceps tendon at the front of the knee. It improves the mechanical efficiency of knee extension, protects the front of the joint, and distributes forces across the femoral trochlea.

Alternate Names:
Rotula; Knee Cap

Patellar Apprehension Test

A knee examination used to look for kneecap instability. The examiner gently moves the kneecap outward while the knee is slightly bent. Fear, pain, or a muscle tightening response may support instability, but the test is interpreted with the history and other findings.

Alternate Names:
Fairbank Apprehension Test

Patellar Bulge Test

A physical examination manoeuvre used to detect small intra-articular effusions in the knee joint. The examiner sweeps the medial aspect of the knee upward to displace fluid, then sweeps downward on the suprapatellar and lateral aspects; a visible fluid bulge or wave returning to the medial hollow indicates a small effusion.

Alternate Names:
Brush Test; Stroke Test; Sweep Test

Patellar Dislocation

Complete displacement of the kneecap from the femoral groove, usually laterally, causing acute pain, deformity, swelling, and difficulty extending the knee.

Patellar Reflex

A monosynaptic deep tendon stretch reflex elicited by sharply tapping the patellar tendon beneath the patella with a reflex hammer, producing involuntary quadriceps contraction and knee extension; tests the integrity of the L3-L4 spinal nerve roots and femoral nerve.

Alternate Names:
Knee-Jerk Reflex

Patellar Tap Test

A clinical examination technique used to detect moderate to large knee joint effusions. The examiner compresses the suprapatellar pouch with one hand and pushes the patella downward against the femoral condyles with the other; a floating sensation followed by a distinct tap or click against the femur confirms fluid accumulation.

Alternate Names:

Patellar Ballottement Test

Patellar Tendinitis

Alternate name; see *Patellar Tendinopathy*.

Patellar Tendinopathy

An overuse mechanical tendinopathy of the patellar tendon near its origin at the inferior pole of the patella, common in jumping athletes, presenting with localized anterior knee pain exacerbated by jumping, squatting, and descending stairs.

Alternate Names:
Jumper Knee

Patellofemoral Instability

A tendency of the patella to move abnormally or dislocate from the femoral trochlea. Risk factors include abnormal trochlear shape, a high-riding patella, ligament insufficiency, altered limb alignment, and previous dislocation.

Patellofemoral Osteoarthritis

Degenerative disease affecting the cartilage and bone surfaces between the kneecap and the femoral groove. It commonly causes pain at the front of the knee with stairs, squatting, kneeling, or prolonged sitting.

Patellofemoral Pain Syndrome

Pain around or behind the kneecap, often worsened by running, stairs, squatting, or sitting with the knee bent. It commonly results from repeated loading, muscle weakness, movement changes, or kneecap tracking problems.

Alternate Names:
Runner's Knee

Patellofemoral Syndrome

Pain around or behind the kneecap related to movement and loading of the patellofemoral joint, often without a major structural injury.

Patent

Patent means open, unobstructed, or functioning, as in a patent airway, vessel, duct, or congenital fetal channel.

Patent Ductus Arteriosus

Persistence after birth of the ductus arteriosus, a fetal blood vessel connecting the pulmonary artery to the aorta. After birth, the vessel normally constricts and closes; if it remains open, blood usually flows from the aorta into the pulmonary artery, potentially increasing blood flow to the lungs and straining the heart. Small openings may cause no symptoms, while the effects of larger openings vary with the infant's circulation. The condition is more common in infants born prematurely.

Patent Ductus Arteriosus (PDA)

Alternate name; see *Patent Ductus Arteriosus*.

Patent Foramen Ovale

A flap-like passage between the heart's upper chambers that remains from fetal circulation because it does not seal completely after birth. It is common and usually causes no problems or need for treatment. In some circumstances, a clot can pass from the venous to the arterial circulation through it (paradoxical embolism). In selected people with a PFO-associated stroke, closure may be considered after evaluation for other causes.

Alternate Names:
PFO

Patent Urachus

A patent urachus is persistence of the fetal channel between the bladder and umbilicus after birth, allowing urine to drain from the umbilicus and predisposing to infection.

Patent Urachus Repair

Surgery to close an abnormal open connection between the bladder and the navel that remains from fetal development. It may stop urine leaking from the umbilicus and prevent infection; treatment depends on the child's anatomy and health.

Paternal Depression

Depression occurring in a father during pregnancy or after a child is born. Symptoms may include

low mood, irritability, withdrawal, sleep or appetite changes, and loss of interest; treatment can help both parent and family.

Paternal Postnatal Depression

Depression in a father during the first year after a baby's birth. It may be linked to stress, sleep loss, previous depression, or a partner's depression and deserves professional assessment.

Paternal Uniparental Disomy 14

Inheritance of both copies of chromosome 14 from the father, causing abnormal expression of imprinted genes in the 14q32 region and usually resulting in Kagami-Ogata syndrome. Features include a small bell-shaped thorax, characteristic facial appearance, abdominal-wall defects, feeding and respiratory problems, and variable developmental impairment; severity and survival vary.

Alternate Names:
UPD(14)pat

Paternity Testing

A DNA test that assesses whether a person is the biological parent of a child. Samples are usually collected from the child and possible parent, and the result reports either exclusion or a calculated probability of biological relationship.

Pathogen

An organism or infectious agent that can enter the body and cause disease. Examples include viruses, bacteria, fungi, and parasites.

Pathogenesis

The way a disease begins and develops, including its causes, changes in cells or tissues, and progression over time. Understanding pathogenesis helps explain symptoms, complications, and possible treatment targets.

Pathogenic

Pathogenic means capable of causing disease in a susceptible host; pathogenicity depends on the organism or factor, dose, route, and host defenses.

Pathogenicity

The capacity of a microorganism to cause disease in a susceptible host. Pathogenicity is a qualitative property, whereas virulence describes the relative degree of disease-causing capacity among strains or organisms.

Pathogenic Variant

A change in DNA with strong evidence that it causes or contributes to a disease. Its importance depends on the gene, the person's symptoms and family history, and whether one or both copies of the gene are affected.

Pathognomonic

Describes a finding considered highly specific for a particular disease. Truly pathognomonic findings are uncommon; most findings must still be interpreted with the history, examination, and other test results.

Pathologic

Pathologic means related to disease or an abnormal structural or functional change, rather than normal anatomy or physiology.

Pathological Fracture

See *Pathologic Fracture*.

Pathological Laughter And Crying

Alternate name; see *Pseudobulbar Affect*.

Pathological Stealing

Alternate name; see *Kleptomania*.

Pathologic Dilatation

Abnormal widening of a hollow organ, duct, blood vessel, or other structure beyond its expected size because of obstruction, weakness, pressure, or disease.

Pathologic Fracture

A break in bone weakened by a disease, such as osteoporosis, cancer, infection, or another bone disorder. It can happen after a minor injury or sometimes

during ordinary activity; treatment addresses both the fracture and its cause.

Pathologic Hypertrophy

Enlargement of an organ because its cells become larger, usually after long-term extra workload or hormone stimulation. It can help at first but may eventually impair function, as in an overworked heart.

Pathologic Nipple Discharge

Nipple fluid that occurs without squeezing, comes from one breast or one duct, or is bloody or clear. Causes include benign duct changes and, less often, breast cancer; evaluation may include imaging and other tests.

Pathologic Ossification

Abnormal formation of bone in soft tissue or in a location where bone should not develop, as in heterotopic ossification after trauma, neurologic injury, or surgery.

Pathologic Process

A pathologic process is an abnormal biological change that produces disease, such as infection, inflammation, ischemia, degeneration, abnormal growth, or immune injury.

Pathologic Response

A pathologic response is an abnormal reaction of cells, tissues, or organs to injury, infection, immune activation, toxins, or other stressors that contributes to disease.

Pathologist

A pathologist is a physician who diagnoses disease by examining tissues, cells, blood, or body fluids and may guide laboratory testing, cancer classification, and treatment decisions.

Pathology

The study and diagnosis of disease through examination of tissues, cells, blood, and other specimens. Anatomic pathology examines cells and tissues; laboratory or clinical pathology studies blood, body fluids, and laboratory processes. General pathology studies disease processes, while systemic pathology focuses on organs.

Pathology Artifact

A change introduced while collecting, preserving, cutting, staining, or imaging a sample rather than by disease. Recognizing these false changes prevents an incorrect diagnosis.

Pathophysiology

The study of the functional changes produced by disease or injury and the mechanisms through which they cause signs and symptoms.

Patient

A person receiving medical care, advice, examination, or treatment. Good care includes listening to the patient's concerns, explaining choices clearly, respecting informed decisions, protecting privacy, and reducing avoidable harm.

Patient Advocacy

Acting on behalf of a patient to ensure that the patient's needs, rights, and preferences are addressed in healthcare.

Patient Autonomy

A patient's right and capacity to make informed voluntary decisions about healthcare after receiving understandable information about options, benefits, risks, and alternatives.

Patient-Centered Care

Healthcare planned around a person's needs, values, preferences, and goals. It includes clear communication, shared decisions, respect for cultural and personal choices, coordination between professionals, and support for the person and family.

Patient-Centered Outcome

An outcome that reflects what matters to the patient, including symptoms, function, quality of life, treatment burden, and ability to achieve personal

goals, rather than relying only on laboratory or imaging measures.

Patient-Controlled Analgesia

A method in which a patient self-administers prescribed doses of analgesic medication using a programmable pump with preset safety limits. The medication, dose, and lockout interval are individualized according to the patient's condition and monitoring needs.

Patient Education

The process of explaining a health condition, treatment, medicines, exercises, equipment, warning signs, and prevention strategies in a way the patient can understand and use.

Patient Observation

Systematic monitoring of a patient's symptoms, vital signs, examination findings, behavior, and response to treatment to detect deterioration or guide management.

Patient Positioning

Placing and supporting a patient in a position that permits safe care, accurate examination or imaging, and adequate comfort.

Patient Preparation

The instructions and assessments completed before a test or procedure, such as fasting, medicine review, hydration, consent, or skin preparation when required.

Patient-Reported Outcome Measure

A validated questionnaire completed directly by a patient to assess symptoms, function, health status, or quality of life without clinician interpretation of the response.

Patient Rights

Ethical and legal protections for people receiving care, including informed consent, privacy, access to information, respectful treatment, participation in decisions, and refusal of treatment where lawful.

Patient Safety

Preventing avoidable harm during healthcare. It includes accurate identification, safe prescribing and medicine use, infection prevention, clear communication, fall prevention, and checking procedures and results.

Patlak-Rutland Analysis

A graph used with some nuclear-medicine scans to estimate how quickly a tracked substance moves from the blood into tissue and stays there. It can help measure tissue activity, including activity in some tumors.

Patrick Test

A hip examination, also called the FABER test, in which the person lies on their back with one ankle resting on the opposite knee. The examiner gently lowers the bent knee; pain may point to a hip or nearby pelvic problem, but the test alone cannot identify the cause.

Alternate Names:
FABER Test; Patrick's FABER Maneuver

Pattern Recognition Receptors

Proteins on or inside immune cells that detect common features of germs or damaged tissue. Their activation helps start the body's early immune response.

Pattern-Recognition Receptors

Sensors on or inside immune cells that detect common features of germs or damaged cells. Their activation starts early immune responses, including inflammation and signals that help coordinate protection and tissue repair.

Pauci-Immune Glomerulonephritis

A necrotizing and crescentic glomerulonephritis characterized on renal biopsy by focal glomerular capillary necrosis and cellular crescent formation with minimal or absent deposition of immunoglobulins or complement on immunofluorescence, strongly associated with antineutrophil cytoplasmic antibodies (ANCA-associated vasculitis).

Alternate Names:

ANCA-Associated Glomerulonephritis; Pauci-Immune Crescentic GN

Pavement Burn

A skin injury caused by sliding against pavement, combining abrasion (scraping away of skin) with tissue damage from friction. It can range from superficial skin loss to a deeper burn, and grit or asphalt may become embedded in the wound.

Alternate Names:
Road Rash

Paxillin

Paxillin is a focal-adhesion adaptor protein that links integrin signaling to the actin cytoskeleton and helps regulate cell adhesion, migration, and mechanical sensing.

PA X-Ray

A posteroanterior X-ray is taken with the beam traveling from the back toward the front, commonly for a chest image. This position reduces enlargement of the heart's outline compared with some other views.

Pazopanib

An oral tyrosine-kinase inhibitor targeting vascular endothelial growth factor and other receptors, used for selected advanced renal-cell carcinoma and soft-tissue sarcoma.

PBA

Alternate name; see *Pseudobulbar Affect*.

PBG Urine Test

A urine test measuring porphobilinogen, used urgently to evaluate suspected acute hepatic porphyria during compatible neurovisceral or abdominal attacks.

PCBs

PCBs, or polychlorinated biphenyls, are persistent industrial chemicals that accumulate in tissues and can affect the nervous, endocrine, immune, and reproductive systems.

PCL Injuries

Sprains or tears of the posterior cruciate ligament, a strong ligament inside the knee. They may follow a blow to the shin or forceful bending and can cause pain, swelling, stiffness, or a feeling that the knee gives way.

PCO

An abbreviation for *polycystic ovaries* in reproductive medicine or *posterior capsule opacification* in ophthalmology. The full term should be given when the field is not clear.

PCO Disease

Nonstandard name; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

PCOS

Abbreviation; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

PCP

Alternate name; see *Pneumocystis Jirovecii Pneumonia*.

PCP and Ketamine Toxicity

Dissociative-drug toxicity causing agitation, hallucinations, impaired coordination, nystagmus, analgesia, tachycardia, hypertension, hyperthermia, seizures, or coma. PCP often produces severe behavioral disturbance, whereas ketamine can cause profound sedation; reduce stimulation, protect the airway, use benzodiazepines when needed, and treat hyperthermia or complications.

PDA

Alternate name; see *Patent Ductus Arteriosus*.

PDE5 Inhibitors

Medicines that improve blood flow into the penis by relaxing blood vessels and are mainly used for erectile dysfunction. Combining them with nitrate medicines can cause a dangerous fall in blood pressure.

Peak Expiratory Flow Rate

The fastest speed at which a person can blow air

out after taking a full breath. A handheld meter measures it in litres per minute; lower or changing values can help monitor airway narrowing, especially in asthma.

Peak Flow Meter

A handheld device that measures peak expiratory flow rate, the fastest speed of air expelled after a full breath, usually reported in liters per minute. It provides a simple measure of large-airway flow but does not measure the full range of airflow and lung volumes assessed by spirometry.

Peak Plasma Concentration

The highest measured concentration of a medicine in the blood after a dose. It is often called Cmax and is influenced by the dose, absorption speed, formulation, and route of administration.

Alternate Names:
Cmax

PE Anticoagulation

Anticoagulant treatment for pulmonary embolism to prevent clot extension and recurrence. Options include direct oral anticoagulants, heparins, and vitamin K antagonists; the choice and duration depend on bleeding risk, pregnancy, kidney function, cancer, provoking factors, and other clinical features.

Peanut Allergy

An immune reaction to peanut proteins that can cause symptoms ranging from hives to life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Peanut Hypersensitivity; Peanut Anaphylaxis

Peanut Oil

Peanut oil is oil extracted from peanuts; refined oil usually contains little allergenic protein, whereas unrefined products may trigger reactions in susceptible people.

Pearly Penile Papules

Small, benign, dome-shaped papules arranged circumferentially around the glans penis, representing normal anatomical variants requiring no treatment.

Peau D'Orange

Peau d'orange is dimpled skin resembling an orange peel, caused by edema tethered around hair follicles; it can occur with breast cancer, infection, or lymphatic obstruction.

Pectinate Line

A boundary inside the anal canal where the lining, nerve supply, blood vessels, and lymph drainage change. Conditions above and below this line may cause different symptoms and may be treated differently.

Pectoral

Relating to the chest muscles or the front of the chest. The pectoral muscles move the arm and help stabilize the shoulder. Pain in this area may come from muscle strain, the ribs, breast tissue, or organs inside the chest.

Pectoral Girdle

The pectoral girdle consists of the clavicles and scapulae, attaching the upper limbs to the trunk and providing broad surfaces for shoulder and arm movement.

Pectoralis

Relating to the chest muscles, especially pectoralis major and pectoralis minor. These muscles help move the arm, support the shoulder, and connect the chest wall with the upper limb.

Pectoralis Major Muscle

The large chest muscle that moves the arm across the body, turns it inward, and helps with pushing. It attaches to the collarbone, breastbone, ribs, and upper arm.

Pectoralis Minor Muscle

A small chest muscle beneath the larger pectoralis major. It helps draw the shoulder blade forward and downward, hold it against the ribs, and assist force-

ful breathing; tightness can contribute to rounded shoulders.

Pectoralis Muscles

The pectoralis major and minor muscles of the chest, which move and stabilize the shoulder and assist with movements such as pushing, adduction, and breathing.

Pectoriloquy

Abnormally clear transmission of spoken sounds through the chest wall, often suggesting lung consolidation or another change in lung tissue.

Pectus Carinatum

A chest-wall deformity in which the sternum and adjacent costal cartilages protrude outward, sometimes asymmetrically. It may be present at birth but often becomes more noticeable during growth, especially puberty. Most people have no physical symptoms, though some experience chest pain, shortness of breath with exertion, or concerns about appearance.

Alternate Names:
Pigeon Chest; Pigeon Breast; Keel Breast

Pectus Excavatum

A chest-wall deformity in which the sternum and adjacent costal cartilages are displaced inward, creating a depression in the chest. It may be mild and cause no symptoms; severe deformity can cause chest pain, shortness of breath, or exercise intolerance and may affect heart or lung function.

Alternate Names:
Sunken Chest; Funnel Chest

Pectus Excavatum Repair

Surgical correction of a sunken sternum and adjacent costal cartilage, performed when chest-wall deformity causes significant symptoms, physiologic impairment, or psychosocial impact.

Pediatric ADHD

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder in children or adolescents, involving developmentally inappropriate inattention, hyperactivity, and/or impulsivity that persist across settings and impair functioning.

Pediatric Advanced Life Support

Emergency training and guidance for recognizing and treating life-threatening breathing, circulation, or heart problems in infants and children. It covers resuscitation, airway support, shock, abnormal rhythms, and care after recovery.

Alternate Names:
PALS

Pediatric AIDS

Pediatric AIDS is advanced HIV infection in a child, with severe immune suppression or AIDS-defining illness; antiretroviral therapy and prevention of opportunistic infection are essential.

Pediatric Anesthesia

Anesthesia for infants and children uses age- and weight-appropriate medicines, equipment, and monitoring. Children's airways and breathing reserves differ from adults, so they can develop low oxygen levels or changes in blood pressure quickly and need specialized care.

Pediatric Antireflux Surgery

Surgical reconstruction of the gastroesophageal junction—most commonly via laparoscopic Nissen fundoplication—in infants and children with medically refractory gastroesophageal reflux disease, recurrent aspiration, or severe failure to thrive.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Fundoplication; Pediatric Anti-Reflux Surgery; Nissen Fundoplication in Children

Pediatric Apnea

A pause or cessation of breathing in an infant or child. Causes include prematurity, infection, airway obstruction, seizures, metabolic disease, medication exposure, and central or obstructive sleep disorders.

Pediatric Appendicitis

Acute inflammation of the vermiform appendix, usually caused by luminal obstruction. Children may have evolving periumbilical-to-right-lower-quadrant

pain, anorexia, vomiting, fever, and guarding, but presentation can be atypical in young children; timely surgical and antimicrobial assessment reduces perforation risk.

Pediatric Assessment Triangle

A rapid first look at a sick child that does not require touching the child. Clinicians observe appearance, effort of breathing, and skin color or circulation. The findings show how urgently help is needed and guide the next examination and treatment.

Alternate Names:
PAT; Pediatric Visual Triage Triangle

Pediatric Brain Tumor

A primary neoplasm originating within the brain parenchyma, ventricular system, meninges, or cranial nerves during childhood or adolescence. As the leading cause of disease-related death in children, common histologic entities include pilocytic astrocytoma, medulloblastoma, ependymoma, atypical teratoid/rhabdoid tumor (AT/RT), and diffuse midline glioma. Clinical presentation reflects increased intracranial pressure (headache, vomiting, papilledema, macrocephaly) or focal neurologic deficits. Multidisciplinary treatment encompasses maximal safe neurosurgical resection, molecular stratification, and risk-adapted adjuvant chemotherapy or craniospinal radiotherapy.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Brain Tumor; Pediatric Brain Tumors; Pediatric CNS Neoplasm

Pediatric Brain Tumors

Plural form; see *Pediatric Brain Tumor*.

Pediatric Cancer

Cancer occurring in infants, children, or adolescents. Common types include leukemia, brain tumors, lymphoma, neuroblastoma, and Wilms tumor; prognosis varies by type and stage.

Pediatric Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

Emergency chest compressions and rescue breaths used when an infant or child has cardiac arrest. Technique, compression depth, and the ratio of compressions to breaths depend on the child's age, number of rescuers, and current resuscitation guidance.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric CPR

Pediatric Cataract

Clouding of the natural lens in an infant or child. It may be present at birth or develop after birth and can interfere with visual development, causing amblyopia or reduced vision.

Pediatric Central Venous Line

A small-caliber central vascular access catheter specifically designed and placed in neonates and pediatric patients for total parenteral nutrition, critical drug infusions, hemodialysis, or advanced hemodynamic monitoring.

Alternate Names:
Neonatal Central Line; Pediatric CVC; Infant Venous Catheter

Pediatric Crutch Gait Training and Fitting

Clinical fitting and rehabilitation gait training for children utilizing axillary or forearm crutches, ensuring proper axillary clearance ($2--3$ finger-breadths) and handgrip alignment to prevent compressive crutch palsy.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Crutch Fitting; Pediatric Gait Training; Axillary Crutch Training in Children; Crutch Gait Training; Crutch Fitting

Pediatric Crutch Stair Training

Physical therapy gait training for pediatric crutch users navigating stairs safely (advancing the unaffected extremity first when ascending, and advancing crutches with the affected extremity when descending).

Alternate Names:
Stair Ambulation with Crutches; Crutch Stair Training

Pediatric Crutch Transfers

Physical therapy instruction for pediatric patients utilizing axillary crutches to safely transition between seated and standing positions by grasping both crutches on the injured side and supporting weight on the unaffected extremity.

Alternate Names:
Crutch Chair Transfers in Children; Crutch Transfers

Pediatric Dehydration

A deficit of body water and electrolytes in a child, commonly caused by vomiting, diarrhea, fever, poor intake, or excessive losses. Signs include reduced urination, dry mucosa, lethargy, tachycardia, and altered perfusion.

Pediatric Dentistry

Dental care for infants, children, and adolescents, including prevention and treatment of tooth decay, care of developing teeth, growth-related problems, behavior support, and adaptations for children with special healthcare needs.

Pediatric Dermatology

The medical specialty concerned with skin, hair, and nail disorders in infants, children, and adolescents. It includes congenital lesions, inflammatory diseases, infections, vascular lesions, and tumors.

Pediatric Dermatology Conditions

Skin conditions in children may include birthmarks, eczema, infections, vascular growths, pigment changes, and inherited disorders. Rapidly changing, painful, bleeding, or infected lesions can indicate significant disease.

Pediatric Diabetic Ketoacidosis

A life-threatening complication of diabetes in which very high blood sugar and a lack of insulin make the blood acidic. A child may urinate and drink excessively, vomit, have abdominal pain, deep breathing, fruity-smelling breath, sleepiness, or coma.

Pediatric Early Warning Score

A hospital scoring system that combines a child's behavior, breathing, heart rate, circulation, and need for oxygen to detect worsening illness early. A rising score indicates increased risk and supports clinical judgment.

Alternate Names:
PEWS; Pediatric Early Warning System

Pediatric Echocardiogram

A noninvasive ultrasound examination of the heart in infants and children used to evaluate congenital structural heart defects, valve function, and cardiac blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Echo; Pediatric Cardiac Ultrasound

Pediatric Eczema

Atopic dermatitis in children commonly begins in infancy with facial and extensor involvement; flexural disease predominates in older children. Pruritus, xerosis, sleep disturbance, and scratching are characteristic.

Pediatric Feeding Tube

A small, flexible plastic tube inserted through the nose (nasogastric/nasojejunal) or directly into the stomach (gastrostomy) to deliver breast milk, formula, or medications to infants unable to feed adequately by mouth.

Alternate Names:
Infant Feeding Tube; Infant Enteral Tube

Pediatric Fever

An elevated body temperature in a child, usually caused by infection but sometimes by inflammation, medicines, or environmental heat. Evaluation depends on age, appearance, duration, and associated findings.

Pediatric Foreign Body Ingestion

Swallowing of a nonfood object by a child, with risk determined by the object, location, size, symptoms, and time since ingestion. Batteries, magnets, sharp objects, and obstructing objects can cause rapid

tissue injury or blockage.

Pediatric Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease

Reflux that causes troublesome symptoms or complications in a child, such as feeding difficulty, pain, or poor growth. Evaluation and treatment depend on the child's age, symptoms, and effect on growth and health.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric GERD; Childhood Acid Reflux; Pediatric Gastroesophageal Reflux

Pediatric Glaucoma

Glaucoma occurring in an infant or child, often involving abnormal development or blockage of the eye's drainage system. Increased eye pressure can enlarge or damage the eye and impair vision.

Pediatric Growth Hormone Deficiency

Inadequate secretion of growth hormone by the anterior pituitary gland in infants and children, leading to deceleration of growth velocity, proportionate short stature, delayed bone age, and abnormal body composition. Causes include pituitary hypoplasia, genetic defects, midline cranial defects, intracranial tumors, radiation therapy, or idiopathic hypopituitarism.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric GH Deficiency; Growth Hormone Deficiency in Children

Pediatric Health

The physical, mental, emotional, and social well-being of infants, children, and adolescents. Care includes prevention, vaccinations, growth and development checks, treatment of illness, and support for the child and family.

Pediatric Heart Surgery

An operation to repair or improve a child's heart or major blood vessels, often for a congenital heart defect. Procedures may close abnormal openings, improve blood flow, or replace a valve; recovery and risks depend on the defect and operation.

Pediatric Hepatitis A

An acute liver infection caused by hepatitis A virus, usually spread through contaminated food or water or close contact with an infected person. It often resolves without chronic infection, though symptoms and severity vary.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Hepatitis A; Pediatric HAV Infection; Acute Viral Hepatitis A in Children

Pediatric Hepatitis B

A liver infection caused by hepatitis B virus, often acquired at birth or in early childhood. Infection acquired in infancy is more likely to become chronic; chronic infection can damage the liver over time.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Hepatitis B

Pediatric Hepatitis C

Infection with the hepatitis C virus (HCV) in infants and children, primarily acquired vertically through perinatal maternal-fetal transmission or through parenteral exposure. Modern direct-acting antiviral (DAA) regimens provide high cure rates in pediatric cohorts.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Hepatitis C; Pediatric HCV Infection

Pediatric Hypercholesterolemia

Elevated circulating total cholesterol or low-density lipoprotein (LDL) levels in children and adolescents. Causes include familial hypercholesterolemia, obesity, insulin resistance, endocrine disorders, or dietary factors.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Hyperlipidemia; Pediatric Dyslipidemia

Pediatric Hypertension

Persistently high blood pressure in a child or adolescent. Diagnosis depends on repeated, properly measured readings interpreted using age, sex, height, or age-specific clinical thresholds; kidney and heart conditions are among possible causes.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Hypertension; Pediatric High Blood Pres-

sure

Pediatrician

A medical doctor who specializes in the health and medical care of children from birth through adolescence (typically up to age 16-18).

Alternate Names:
Paediatrician

Pediatric Limp

An abnormal walking pattern or refusal to walk in a child. Causes range from minor injury and transient synovitis to infection, fracture, inflammatory disease, neuromuscular disease, or malignancy; fever, severe pain, swelling, or inability to bear weight can indicate serious disease.

Pediatric Meningitis

Inflammation or infection of the coverings of a child's brain and spinal cord. Fever, headache, stiff neck, vomiting, light sensitivity, confusion, seizures, or a rash may occur; babies may be irritable, feed poorly, or have a bulging soft spot. It can progress quickly and is life-threatening.

Pediatric Midline Catheters

Peripheral intravenous catheters in children whose tips end in a vein of the upper arm rather than a central vein. They are used when longer access is needed than a short peripheral IV can provide; suitable solutions and duration depend on the device and clinical need.

Pediatric Myocarditis

Acute or chronic inflammation of the myocardium in infants and children, most commonly triggered by viral infections (enteroviruses, adenovirus, parvovirus B19, SARS-CoV-2) or post-infectious autoimmune responses. Manifests as tachypnea, poor feeding, tachycardia, cardiomegaly, arrhythmias, or acute congestive heart failure.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Myocarditis; Pediatric Myocardial Inflammation

Pediatric Nasal Congestion

A stuffy or runny nose in a child is usually caused by a viral infection or allergy; breathing difficulty, dehydration, prolonged fever, or symptoms in an infant can indicate a more serious illness.

Pediatric Nursing

Pediatric nursing provides age-appropriate care to infants, children, and adolescents, accounting for growth, development, family involvement, communication, safety, and medication differences.

Pediatric Obesity

Excess body fat in a child or adolescent, assessed by comparing weight and height with other children of the same age and sex. It can affect breathing, joints, blood sugar, sleep, and emotional wellbeing; stigma can worsen emotional and social effects.

Pediatric Obstructive Sleep Apnea

Repeated narrowing or blockage of a child's throat during sleep, causing pauses in breathing, snoring, restless sleep, daytime behavior or attention problems, and sometimes poor growth. Enlarged tonsils or adenoids are common causes.

Pediatric Ophthalmology

The ophthalmology subspecialty concerned with eye and vision disorders in infants, children, and adolescents. It includes strabismus and amblyopia, congenital and developmental eye conditions, refractive disorders, and other diseases affecting vision during childhood.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Ophthalmology and Strabismus

Pediatric Orthopedics

The branch of orthopedics focused on bone, joint, muscle, and movement problems in infants, children, and adolescents. It includes developmental conditions, limb differences, fractures, sports injuries, spine deformities, and growth-related disorders.

Pediatric Pancreatitis

Acute or chronic inflammatory disease of the pan-

creas in infants, children, and adolescents. Common pediatric etiologies include abdominal blunt trauma, viral infections (mumps, Coxsackie, EBV), medications, systemic illness, gallstones, and genetic mutations (*PRSS1*, *SPINK1*, *CFTR*).

Alternate Names:
Childhood Pancreatitis; Pediatric Pancreatic Inflammation

Pediatric Pneumonia

Infection or inflammation of the lung tissue in an infant, child, or adolescent. It may cause cough, fever, fast or difficult breathing, chest pain, or low oxygen and can be caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or aspiration.

Pediatric Poisoning

Harmful exposure to a medicine, chemical, plant, gas, or other toxic substance in an infant, child, or adolescent. Effects depend on the agent, amount, route, formulation, age, and time since exposure and may range from no symptoms to severe illness.

Pediatric Ptosis

Drooping of the upper eyelid in an infant or child, present from birth or acquired later. If it blocks vision, it can interfere with visual development; assessment depends on its cause and severity.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Blepharoptosis; Childhood Drooping Eyelid

Pediatric Pump Gastrostomy Feeding

Continuous or intermittent enteral nutrition delivered to pediatric patients through a gastrostomy tube using an electronic feeding pump. Provides precise, controlled flow rates and volumes for children who cannot tolerate bolus feeding.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Enteral Pump Feeding; Pediatric G-Tube Pump Feeding; Continuous Enteral Infusion

Pediatric Pyloric Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis* and *Pyloric Stenosis*.

Pediatric Rash Evaluation

Assessment of a rash in an infant or child, considering its appearance, location, timing, associated symptoms, and possible infectious, allergic, inflammatory, or other causes. Fever, severe illness, breathing difficulty, or purple spots that do not fade when pressed can indicate a serious condition.

Pediatric Rehabilitation

Therapy that helps children with conditions present from birth, injuries, illness, or developmental disabilities gain skills and independence. Care considers growth, family goals, school participation, communication, movement, learning, and daily activities.

Pediatrics

The medical specialty concerned with the physical, developmental, emotional, and social health of infants, children, and adolescents, extending into young adulthood in some settings. Pediatric care includes health promotion and prevention, and diagnosis and treatment of acute and chronic illness, with attention to growth and development.

Alternate Names:
Paediatrics

Pediatric Sepsis

Sepsis occurring in an infant, child, or adolescent, in which the body's response to infection causes organ dysfunction. Signs vary with age and may include abnormal temperature, breathing difficulty, unusual sleepiness, poor feeding, or reduced urine.

Pediatric Shock

A dangerous condition in which a child's organs do not receive enough blood flow or oxygen. Causes include severe fluid loss, infection, heart failure, or a blockage. Early signs may include a fast heartbeat, pale or cold skin, unusual sleepiness, confusion, or little urine.

Pediatric Skin Tumors

Skin growths in children include harmless birth-related or blood-vessel growths, cysts, and, rarely, cancer. Rapid growth, bleeding, ulceration, color change, or pain can occur in significant lesions.

Pediatric Sleep Apnea

Pediatric sleep apnea is repeated interruption or reduction of breathing during sleep, commonly from enlarged tonsils or adenoids, causing snoring, restless sleep, behavior changes, or impaired growth.

Pediatric Total Parenteral Nutrition

Intravenous nutrition for a child who cannot receive enough nutrients through the digestive tract. It requires careful monitoring of blood sugar, salts, liver function, infection, and catheter complications.

Pediatric Toxicology

The medical study and treatment of poisoning or harmful exposure in children. Common exposures include medicines, iron, household chemicals, and plants. Symptoms vary with the substance and may include vomiting, sleepiness, breathing problems, seizures, or burns; severe exposures can progress rapidly.

Pediatric Volvulus

Twisting of a loop of intestine around its mesentery, causing obstruction and potentially loss of blood supply. In children it is often related to intestinal malrotation and is a surgical emergency when acute.

Pedicle

A pedicle is a stalk or attachment containing vessels, nerves, or other supporting structures, such as the base of a polyp, flap, or vertebral arch.

Pedicle Skin Graft

A piece of skin moved to cover a wound while remaining attached to its original blood supply through a tissue bridge.

Pediculosis

Infestation with lice, small insects that live on the scalp, body, or pubic hair. It causes itching and spreads mainly through close contact or shared personal items.

Pediculosis and Pthiriasis (Lice Infestation)

Infestation of scalp, body, or pubic hair by lice. It may cause itching, visible lice or attached eggs, excoriations, or secondary skin infection; the affected site and louse species determine the clinical features.

Pediculosis Capitis

Alternate name; see *Head Lice*.

Pediculus Humanus Capitis

A blood-sucking parasite commonly known as the louse (plural, lice) that can cause an itchy scalp; infestations are highly contagious and especially common in school-age children.

Pedigree

A family diagram that shows relationships and who has a particular trait or disease. Doctors and genetic counselors use it to look for inheritance patterns and estimate the chance that relatives may be affected.

Pedodontics

The branch of dentistry concerned with infants, children, and adolescents.

Pedophilia

A continuing sexual interest in children who have not reached puberty. The term describes an interest and is not synonymous with pedophilic disorder; sexual contact with a child is abuse and cannot be consensual.

Pedophilic Disorder

A mental-health disorder involving recurrent, intense sexual fantasies, urges, or behaviors toward children who have not reached puberty. Diagnostic criteria include clinically significant distress or impairment, or acting on the urges, together with required age and duration criteria.

Pedunculate

Pedunculate describes a structure, lesion, or polyp attached by a narrow stalk rather than a broad base.

Pedunculated

Attached to the skin or another surface by a narrow stalk, rather than having a broad base.

Peeling Skin

Loss or shedding of the outer layer of skin, which may result from dryness, sunburn, irritation, allergy, infection, inflammation, or a systemic illness.

PEEP

Pressure kept in the airways at the end of breathing out, usually by a ventilator or breathing machine. It helps keep the lung air sacs open and improve oxygen levels, but too much pressure can injure the lungs or lower blood flow.

PEF

PEF, or peak expiratory flow, is the fastest airflow produced during a forceful exhalation and is used chiefly to monitor variable airway obstruction such as asthma.

PEG Tube

A flexible feeding tube placed through the abdominal wall into the stomach with camera guidance. It provides nutrition, fluids, or medicines when swallowing is unsafe or inadequate, and requires regular skin care.

Pel-Ebstein Fever

A historical term for a pattern of fever that rises and falls in cycles and has been described in Hodgkin lymphoma. The association and diagnostic value are uncertain; the pattern is not a reliable sign of lymphoma.

Alternate Names:
Pel-Ebstein Pattern; Cyclical Lymphoma Fever

Peliosis Hepatis

A usually uncommon condition in which multiple blood-filled spaces form within the liver. It may be linked to medicines, hormones, toxins, infections, cancer, or other diseases. It often causes no symptoms but can rarely cause liver failure or life-threatening bleeding if a space ruptures.

Pelizaeus-Merzbacher Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which the brain does not make myelin, the protective covering around nerve fibers, normally. It usually begins in infancy with poor muscle tone, unusual eye movements, and delayed development, followed by stiffness, balance problems, and increasing movement difficulty. There is no cure; care supports movement, feeding, breathing, and communication.

Alternate Names:
PMD; PLP1-Related Hypomyelinating Leukodystrophy

Pellagra

A disease caused by too little niacin, leading to skin changes, diarrhea, and problems with thinking.

Pellet

A pellet is a small compacted mass of medication, material, or tissue; drug pellets may be formulated for implantation or controlled release.

Pelvic

Relating to the pelvis, the bony ring and associated organs, muscles, vessels, and nerves in the lower trunk.

Pelvic Binder

A circumferential device applied around the pelvis to reduce motion and hemorrhage from suspected unstable pelvic-ring injury. It is centered over the greater trochanters as part of hemorrhage control and definitive injury management.

Pelvic Bone

One of the two hip bones forming the sides and front of the pelvis. Each hip bone joins the sacrum and supports the trunk while protecting pelvic organs.

Pelvic Cavity

The space inside the lower part of the body enclosed by the pelvic bones. It contains the bladder, rectum, reproductive organs, blood vessels, nerves, and supporting muscles.

Pelvic Congestion

Enlargement or pooling of blood in the veins of the pelvis, which may cause pelvic pressure, discomfort, or pain.

Pelvic Congestion Syndrome

Chronic pelvic pain associated with enlarged or inefficient pelvic veins, often worsening with prolonged standing, before menstruation, or after intercourse. Diagnosis requires evaluation for other causes of pelvic pain and may involve pelvic imaging; treatment is individualized by gynecology or vascular specialists.

Pelvic CT Scan

Computed tomography of the pelvis using x-rays and computer reconstruction to evaluate bones, organs, soft tissues, masses, trauma, infection, and bleeding.

Pelvic Diaphragm

The group of muscles and supporting tissue forming the floor of the pelvis. It supports the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs and helps control urine and stool.

Pelvic Examination

Clinical inspection and palpation of the external genitalia, vagina, cervix, uterus, and adnexa to evaluate bleeding, pain, discharge, lesions, pregnancy-related findings, or infection.

Pelvic Exenteration

Very extensive surgery removing some pelvic organs and nearby tissues, usually for selected cancers that have returned or grown locally when less extensive treatment cannot control them. Recovery is prolonged and reconstruction may be needed.

Pelvic Floor

A group of muscles and connective tissues supporting the pelvic organs and controlling urinary and fecal continence.

Pelvic Floor Dysfunction

Weakness, overactivity, poor coordination, or injury of the muscles and connective tissues supporting the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs. Symptoms may include urinary or fecal problems, pelvic pain, constipation, pain with sex, or pelvic organ prolapse; assessment may involve pelvic-health clinicians.

Pelvic Floor Health And Disorders

The pelvic floor is a group of muscles and supporting tissues that hold the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs in place and help control urine, stool, and sexual function. Weakness, tightness, injury, or poor coordination can cause pain, leakage, constipation, or prolapse.

Pelvic Floor Muscles

Muscles at the bottom of the pelvis that support the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs and help control urine, stool, and sexual function.

Pelvic Floor Muscle Training Exercises

Pelvic floor muscle exercises strengthen the muscles supporting the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs and may improve selected forms of urinary or fecal leakage.

Pelvic Fracture

A break in one or more bones of the pelvic ring, often caused by major trauma but sometimes occurring in weakened bone. The injury may be stable or unstable and can be associated with bleeding or damage to nearby organs, nerves, or blood vessels.

Pelvic Girdle

The ring of bones connecting the lower limbs to the trunk, consisting of the hip bones, sacrum, and associated joints.

Pelvic Girdle Pain In Pregnancy

Pain around the front or back of the pelvis during pregnancy. It may involve the joint at the front of the pelvis or the joints at the back, and can spread to the hips or thighs. Walking, climbing stairs, turning in bed, or moving the legs apart may make the pain worse.

Pelvic Infection

An infection involving pelvic organs or tissues, including pelvic inflammatory disease, urinary infection, abscess, or postoperative infection.

Pelvic Inflammatory Disease

An infection of the upper reproductive organs, including the uterus, fallopian tubes, ovaries, or nearby tissues. It usually develops when bacteria spread upward from the vagina or cervix; chlamydia and gonorrhea are common causes, but other bacteria can also be involved. Symptoms may include lower-abdominal pain, unusual discharge or bleeding, or pain during sex, although some people have few or no symptoms. Scarring may cause long-term pelvic pain, infertility, or ectopic pregnancy.

Pelvic Inflammatory Disease (PID)

Alternate name; see *Pelvic Inflammatory Disease*.

Pelvic Inlet

The upper opening of the bony birth canal, formed by the lower spine, hip bones, and front pelvic joint. Its shape and size help determine how a baby can pass through the pelvis during childbirth.

Pelvic Kidney

A kidney that remains in the pelvis rather than ascending to its usual lumbar position during development; it may be asymptomatic or associated with abnormal drainage, stones, infection, or vascular anatomy.

Pelvic Laparoscopy

A minimally invasive procedure using a camera inserted through small abdominal incisions to inspect and treat pelvic organs and structures.

Pelvic Lymphadenectomy

Pelvic lymphadenectomy is surgical removal of lymph nodes in the pelvis to check for or treat spread of cancer.

Pelvic Mass

A lump or abnormal enlargement in the pelvis arising from reproductive, urinary, gastrointestinal, lymphatic, or other tissues.

Pelvic Neoplasm

A pelvic neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the pelvis, arising from organs, bones, soft tissues, or lymph nodes; it may be benign or malignant.

Pelvic Organ Prolapse

Dropping or bulging of the bladder, uterus, rectum, or nearby tissue into or toward the vagina because supporting muscles and tissues have weakened. It may cause pressure, a vaginal bulge, urinary or bowel problems, or discomfort during sex.

Pelvic Organ Prolapse Quantification System

A standard examination used to measure how far the vagina, uterus, bladder, or rectum has moved downward. Measurements are taken while bearing down and describe the severity of prolapse to help plan treatment.

Alternate Names:
POP-Q System; POP-Q Classification

Pelvic Outlet

The lower opening of the bony pelvis and birth canal, bordered by the pubic bone, sitting bones, and tailbone. Its shape and size affect passage through the pelvis during childbirth.

Pelvic Pain

Pain in the lower abdomen, pelvis, or area between the genitals and anus. Causes include reproductive, urinary, bowel, muscle, nerve, and other conditions. Sudden severe pain, pregnancy, fever, fainting, vomiting, or heavy bleeding can indicate an emergency.

Pelvic Pain During Early Pregnancy

Pain in the pelvis or lower abdomen during early pregnancy, caused by normal uterine changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, ovarian disease, infection, or other conditions. Severe or one-sided pain, shoulder pain, fainting, fever, or vaginal bleeding can indicate an emergency.

Pelvic Ring Fracture

A high-energy traumatic skeletal disruption of the pelvic ring structure (involving the sacrum, sacroiliac joints, and pubic rami), classified by Young-Burgess mechanism (lateral compression, anteroposterior compression, vertical shear); frequently complicated by life-threatening retroperitoneal venous plexus hemorrhage.

Pelvic Spleen

A spleen located unusually low in the abdomen or pelvis because its supporting tissues are loose or absent. It may feel like a pelvic lump and can twist, lose its blood supply, or rupture, causing sudden pain and internal bleeding.

Pelvic Ultrasound

An ultrasound imaging examination of the female or male pelvic organs, including the uterus, ovaries, bladder, or prostate; see *Transabdominal Pelvic Ultrasound* and *Transvaginal Ultrasound*.

Pelvic Viscus

An organ located in the pelvic cavity, such as the bladder, rectum, uterus, ovaries, prostate, or related structures.

Pelvimeter

An instrument used to estimate the size and shape of the pelvis, especially during obstetric assessment. Pelvic measurements are only one part of judging whether vaginal birth is likely and are interpreted with the clinical situation.

Pelvimetry

Measurement of the size and shape of the pregnant person's pelvis, usually for selected childbirth concerns. Results are considered with the baby's position, size, labor progress, and overall clinical situation.

Pelvis

The bony ring and associated soft tissues at the base of the trunk, connecting the spine with the lower limbs.

Pelvis MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the pelvis used to evaluate organs, muscles, bones, joints, nerves, blood vessels, and soft-tissue disease without ionizing radiation.

Pelvis X-Ray

Plain radiographic imaging of the pelvic bones and hips used to evaluate fractures, alignment, arthritis, deformity, and selected bone lesions.

Pemberton Sign

Facial redness or bluish discoloration, neck-vein swelling, or breathing difficulty that appears when both arms are raised. It may suggest that an enlarged thyroid or another chest mass is pressing on major veins or the airway.

Pemberton'S Sign

Facial redness or bluish discoloration, neck-vein swelling, or breathing difficulty that appears when both arms are raised. It may suggest that an enlarged thyroid or another chest mass is pressing on major veins or the airway.

Pemetrexed

Pemetrexed is a folate-antimetabolite chemotherapy drug that inhibits several enzymes involved in nucleotide synthesis, used especially for mesothelioma and nonsquamous non-small-cell lung cancer; folic acid and vitamin B12 reduce toxicity.

Pemetrexed Disodium

The disodium salt of pemetrexed, an antifolate chemotherapy medicine used with other treatment for selected non-small-cell lung cancer and mesothelioma.

Pemoline

Pemoline is a stimulant formerly used for attention-deficit disorders; serious liver toxicity led to withdrawal or severe restriction in many countries.

Pemphigoid

A group of immune-system diseases that cause

firm, often itchy blisters when antibodies attack the deeper layers of skin or mucous membranes. The type, location, age, and associated illness determine treatment.

Pemphigoid Gestationis

An autoimmune blistering disease of pregnancy characterised by intensely pruritic urticarial plaques and tense vesicles or bullae, typically arising in the second or third trimester around the umbilicus and spreading to the trunk and extremities.

Pemphigus

A group of autoimmune blistering diseases caused by antibodies that disrupt adhesion between epidermal cells. This produces fragile blisters and erosions on the skin, mucous membranes, or both, depending on the type.

Pemphigus Erythematosus

A localized superficial pemphigus variant with fragile blisters, erosions, and crusted plaques, often in seborrheic areas such as the face, scalp, and upper chest. Autoantibodies disrupt epidermal cell adhesion; diagnosis generally requires biopsy and immunofluorescence.

Pemphigus Foliaceus

An autoimmune blistering disease in which antibodies, usually against the skin protein desmoglein 1, loosen connections between cells in the upper epidermis. This produces very superficial, fragile blisters that break easily and leave scaly or crusted erosions, often on the scalp, face, or trunk. The disease usually affects the skin and spares mucous membranes, unlike pemphigus vulgaris.

Alternate Names:
Brazilian Pemphigus Foliaceus; Endemic Pemphigus Foliaceus; Fogo Selvagem; South American Pemphigus

Pemphigus Vulgaris

A rare autoimmune blistering disease that often begins with painful sores in the mouth and can also cause fragile blisters on the skin or other moist linings. The blisters break easily, leaving raw areas that can lead to infection, fluid loss, or difficulty eating and drinking.

Penbutolol

Penbutolol is a beta-blocker formerly used for high blood pressure; it can slow the heart rate and worsen asthma in susceptible people.

Pencil Eraser Swallowing

Swallowing a small pencil eraser usually causes little poisoning risk, but it may lodge in the airway or digestive tract. Choking, breathing difficulty, persistent vomiting, or severe pain can indicate obstruction or injury.

Pencil Swallowing

Swallowing a pencil or part of one can injure the mouth, throat, or digestive tract and may block the airway. Breathing trouble, bleeding, or severe pain can indicate a serious injury or obstruction.

Pendred Syndrome

An autosomal recessive genetic disorder caused by biallelic mutations in the SLC26A4 gene encoding the anion exchanger pendrin, characterized by congenital bilateral sensorineural hearing loss, temporal bone malformations (enlarged vestibular aqueduct), and euthyroid or hypothyroid multinodular goiter.

Alternate Names:
Pendred's Syndrome; Goiter and Sensorineural Deafness Syndrome

Pendular

Moving or swinging freely like a pendulum; pendular nystagmus has a similar speed in both directions.

Pendular Nystagmus

Involuntary, rhythmic, sinusoidal oscillations of the eyes in which the movements in both directions occur at equal velocity without distinct fast or slow phases. It most commonly arises from congenital visual deprivation, optic nerve abnormalities, or demyelinating brainstem diseases.

Pendulous

Pendulous means hanging loosely from a supporting structure, as in a pedunculated lesion, drooping tissue, or an organ suspended by a stalk.

Penetrance

The proportion of people with a particular gene change who develop the related trait or condition. Penetrance may be complete, incomplete, or influenced by other factors.

Penetrating Abdominal Trauma

Injury to the abdomen caused by a projectile, sharp object, or other penetrating force. It may damage abdominal organs or blood vessels and requires urgent assessment for internal bleeding or organ injury; management depends on the mechanism, examination, stability, and imaging findings.

Penetrating Wounds

Injuries caused when an object enters the skin and damages underlying tissue. They may injure blood vessels, nerves, organs, or bones and can involve bleeding, contamination, retained objects, or infection.

Penicillin

A family of antibiotics that kill bacteria by stopping them from making cell walls. Different types treat different bacterial infections; they do not work against viruses. Allergy, resistance, and kidney problems can affect the choice of medicine.

Penicillin Allergy

An immune reaction to penicillin antibiotics that may cause rash, swelling, breathing difficulty, or anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Penicillin Hypersensitivity; Beta-Lactam Allergy

Penicillin G

Penicillin G is an injectable penicillin antibiotic used for infections such as syphilis and selected streptococcal or other susceptible bacterial infections.

Penicillin V

Penicillin V is an oral penicillin antibiotic used for selected susceptible infections, including some throat and dental infections.

Penicillium

A genus of molds that includes species used to make medicines and foods and species that can cause allergy or opportunistic infection.

Penile

Penile means relating to the penis, the external male organ involved in urination and sexual reproduction.

Penile Adhesions

Abnormal attachment of penile skin to the glans, often after circumcision or during childhood. They may cause irritation or conceal part of the glans and are assessed and treated according to severity.

Penile Augmentation

A cosmetic or reconstructive procedure intended to increase penile length, girth, or both. Techniques and results vary, and complications may include scarring, deformity, infection, altered sensation, or erectile problems.

Penile Cancer

An uncommon cancer of the penis, usually arising from surface skin cells. It may appear as a persistent sore, lump, bleeding area, or skin change; HPV, smoking, foreskin problems, and chronic inflammation can increase risk.

Penile Disease

A disorder affecting the penis, including infection, inflammation, erectile or structural disease, trauma, skin disease, or malignancy.

Penile Edema

Swelling of the penis caused by inflammation, infection, trauma, allergic reaction, impaired lymphatic drainage, or a constricting ring or retracted foreskin. Sudden painful swelling with an irreducible foreskin is an emergency.

Penile Erection

Stiffening and enlargement of the penis when blood fills erectile tissue and is temporarily held there. It can occur with sexual or other stimulation; persistent difficulty getting or keeping an erection may be erectile dysfunction.

Penile Fracture

A tear in the tough tissue around the erectile chambers, usually after an erect penis is bent forcefully. It may cause a popping sound, sudden loss of erection, swelling, bruising, or blood at the urinary opening.

Penile Hygiene

Routine cleaning and drying of the penis and foreskin, with gentle retraction only when it moves freely and replacement afterward. Good hygiene helps reduce irritation and infection without harsh soaps or forceful retraction.

Penile Implant

A surgically implanted device used to produce penile rigidity in selected people with erectile dysfunction that has not responded to other treatments.

Penile Infection

Infection of the penis or foreskin caused by bacteria, fungi, viruses, or parasites, producing pain, redness, discharge, sores, or swelling.

Penile Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Abnormal surface cells on the penis that have not grown into deeper tissue. It may appear as a lasting red, white, scaly, or wart-like patch on the head or foreskin and can be linked to HPV or long-term inflammation. Some cases may develop into penile cancer.

Alternate Names:
PeIN

Penile Intraepithelial Neoplasia (PeIN or PIN)

Alternate name; see *Penile Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Penile Leukoplakia

A persistent white patch on penile skin or mucosa that may reflect irritation, inflammation, or a precancerous disorder.

Penile Lichen Sclerosus

A chronic inflammatory and sclerosing disorder of the penile skin and foreskin, causing pale tight skin, itching, fissures, pain, or narrowing. It can scar the foreskin or urethral opening and requires treatment and surveillance for complications.

Penile Prosthesis

An implanted device used to produce an erection when erectile dysfunction has not improved with other treatments. It may be inflatable or bendable. Surgery can cause infection, bleeding, pain, device failure, or erosion into nearby tissue.

Penile Torsion

Rotation of the penis around its longitudinal axis, usually a congenital condition in which the glans or urethral opening is rotated. Symptomatic or marked torsion may require urologic evaluation and surgical correction.

Penile Trauma

Injury to the penis caused by blunt force, bending, penetration, crushing, burns, bites, or medical instruments. It may damage the skin, erectile tissue, blood vessels, or urethra. A penile fracture is a tear in the covering of the erectile tissue, usually after forceful bending of an erect penis. It may cause pain, swelling, bruising, bleeding, or difficulty passing urine.

Penis

An external genital organ that contains the outlet for urine and can deliver sperm during sexual activity. It becomes firm when filled with blood during an erection and contains sensitive tissue, skin, blood vessels, and nerves.

Penis Carcinoma

Penis carcinoma is cancer of the penis, most often arising from skin or squamous cells and sometimes

linked to HPV infection.

Penis Pain

Penis pain may result from infection, injury, inflammation, urinary problems, or sexual conditions; severe pain, swelling, discharge, or inability to urinate can indicate a serious condition.

Penile Abscess

A pocket of pus in the skin or deeper tissue of the penis, usually caused by infection. It can cause a painful lump, redness, swelling, or fever.

Penile Cellulitis

A bacterial infection of the skin and soft tissue of the penis. It can cause spreading redness, warmth, pain, and swelling.

Penile Eczema

Eczema affecting the skin of the penis, often causing itching, dryness, redness, or soreness; see *Eczema*.

Penile Fibrosis

Scarring within the erectile tissue or its covering. It may cause a firm area, bending during erection, shortening, or difficulty getting or keeping an erection. Peyronie disease is a form of fibrosis affecting the covering of the erectile chambers.

Penile Hemangioma

A usually noncancerous growth of blood vessels in the skin or tissue of the penis. It may appear as a red, blue, or purple mark or lump and may be present from birth.

Penile Hematoma

A collection of blood under the skin or within penile tissue, usually after an injury. It causes bruising and swelling and can occur with or without a tear in the covering of the erectile chambers.

Penile Lymphangitis

Inflammation or swelling of lymph vessels in the penis. A firm cord near the rim of the glans may be a benign form called sclerosing lymphangitis; this differs from penile Mondor disease, which affects a vein.

Penile Lymphedema

Persistent swelling of the penis caused by poor drainage of lymph fluid. It may be present from birth or develop after infection, surgery, radiation, or blockage of lymph vessels.

Penile Lymphangioma

A usually noncancerous growth or malformation of lymph vessels in the penis. It may appear as small clear or skin-colored bumps or a soft swelling.

Penile Melanoma

A rare cancer of pigment-producing cells on the penis. It may appear as a changing dark or unevenly colored spot, lump, or sore; some melanomas have little or no color.

Penile Melanosis

Flat brown or black patches on penile skin caused by extra pigment. These patches are usually harmless, but their appearance can overlap with melanoma.

Penile Mondor Disease

A usually temporary clot and inflammation in a surface vein along the penis, most often the superficial dorsal vein. It may feel like a tender, firm cord on the shaft and is different from sclerosing lymphangitis, which affects a lymph vessel.

Alternate Names:
Penile Mondor's Disease; Penile Mondor's Disease

Penile Papules

Small bumps on the penis; this broad description has several causes. Pearly penile papules are a harmless normal variation arranged around the rim of the glans; see *Pearly Penile Papules*.

Penile Psoriasis

Psoriasis affecting penile skin, which may appear as smooth, red or darker patches with little scale; see *Psoriasis*.

Psoriasis of the Penis

Alternate name; see *Psoriasis*.

Penile Vitiligo

Loss of skin pigment in patches on the penis; see *Vitiligo*.

Penile Calciphylaxis

A rare form of calciphylaxis affecting penile skin, in which calcium builds up in small blood vessels and blocks blood flow. It can cause severe pain, ulcers, or tissue death, usually in people with advanced kidney disease; see *Calciphylaxis*.

Penile Frenular Tear

A split or cut in the short band of tissue connecting the underside of the glans to the foreskin. It can cause pain and bleeding, especially during erection; a short frenulum can make tearing more likely.

Alternate Names:
Frenular Tear

Penoscrotal Transposition

A congenital difference in which the penis and scrotum are positioned abnormally relative to each other, often associated with hypospadias or other genital and urinary anomalies.

Pentad Of TTP

The five findings once considered typical of thrombotic thrombocytopenic purpura: low platelets, destruction of red blood cells, neurologic symptoms, kidney problems, and fever. Most patients do not have all five, and laboratory testing identifies the disorder.

Pentalogy of Cantrell

A rare congenital thoracoabdominal malformation syndrome characterized by the constellation of five midline defects: midline supraumbilical abdominal wall defect (omphalocele), lower sternal cleft defect, anterior diaphragmatic defect, diaphragmatic pericardial defect, and congenital intracardiac anomalies (such as ectopia cordis and VSD).

Alternate Names:
Thoracoabdominal Syndrome; Cantrell Pentalogy

Pentamidine

An antimicrobial medicine used for certain parasitic infections and Pneumocystis pneumonia, with potentially serious side effects.

Pentamidine Isethionate

An antiprotozoal and antimicrobial drug used in selected cases of Pneumocystis pneumonia, leishmaniasis, trypanosomiasis, and other infections; toxicity includes hypoglycemia, kidney injury, and arrhythmia.

Pentatrichomonas Hominis

Pentatrichomonas hominis is a flagellated intestinal protozoan generally regarded as nonpathogenic; finding it in stool usually indicates exposure to fecal contamination.

Pentazocine

An opioid pain medicine with mixed agonist and antagonist effects, used for some moderate or severe pain. It can cause drowsiness, dependence, and slowed breathing and may trigger withdrawal in a person dependent on other opioids.

Pentazocine Overdose

Taking too much pentazocine, an opioid pain medicine, can cause extreme sleepiness, confusion, slow breathing, pinpoint pupils, seizures, or coma. Severe overdose can be fatal; naloxone can reverse opioid-related respiratory depression.

Pentetic Acid

A chelating compound that binds metal ions and is used in selected radiopharmaceuticals, contrast agents, or laboratory applications.

Pentobarbital Overdose

Exposure to an excessive amount of pentobarbital, a sedative, can severely slow brain activity and breathing, causing low blood pressure, coma, or death. Risk increases with alcohol or other sedatives.

Pentosan Polysulfate

A semi-synthetic sulfated polysaccharide used for selected bladder pain syndrome and historically as an anticoagulant; prolonged use can cause pigmentary maculopathy and bleeding.

Pentose

A pentose is a five-carbon sugar, including ribose in RNA and deoxyribose in DNA, and participates in nucleotide and carbohydrate metabolism.

Pentose Phosphate Pathway

A cell pathway that uses glucose to make NADPH, which protects cells from chemical damage, and ribose, which helps build DNA and RNA. It is especially important in the liver and red blood cells.

Pentoxifylline

A methylxanthine derivative that improves red-cell flexibility and is used in some countries for peripheral vascular disease; benefit varies by condition.

Penumbra

Brain tissue surrounding an area of infarction that is functionally impaired but potentially salvageable if blood flow is restored promptly.

Peplomycin

Peplomycin is a bleomycin-related chemotherapy medicine used in some countries for selected cancers; lung toxicity is an important risk.

Peppermint

Mentha piperita, used as a flavoring and in some preparations for dyspeptic symptoms; concentrated oil can be hazardous.

Peppermint Oil Overdose

Swallowing a large amount of peppermint oil can cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, dizziness, allergic reactions, seizures, or lung injury if aspirated.

Pepsin

A stomach enzyme that begins breaking proteins into smaller fragments. It is released as inactive pepsinogen and activated by stomach acid, helping digestion before food enters the small intestine.

Pepsin A

Pepsin A is a stomach protease activated by acid that begins digestion of dietary proteins into smaller peptides.

Pepsinogen

An inactive precursor released by gastric chief cells and converted to pepsin in acidic conditions.

Peptic Esophagitis

Inflammation and injury of the esophageal lining caused mainly by repeated gastroesophageal reflux of acid or bile, producing heartburn, chest discomfort, swallowing pain, or strictures.

Peptic Stricture

A circumferential, fibrotic luminal narrowing of the distal esophagus resulting from chronic, untreated acid peptic injury and collagen deposition in severe gastroesophageal reflux disease (GERD), presenting with progressive solid food dysphagia.

Alternate Names:
Esophageal Peptic Stricture

Peptic Ulcer

A sore or open wound that develops in the protective lining of the stomach (gastric ulcer) or the upper section of the small intestine (duodenal ulcer). It occurs when the stomach's protective mucus layer is weakened, allowing acidic digestive juices to erode the underlying tissue. The most common causes are chronic infection with *Helicobacter pylori* bacteria and regular use of nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs) such as ibuprofen. Typical symptoms include a burning stomach pain, feeling bloated, nausea, and indigestion.

Alternate Names:
Gastric or Duodenal Ulcer; Peptic Ulcer Disease; PUD

Peptic Ulcer Bleeding

Haemorrhage caused by erosion of an artery or other blood vessel beneath a gastric or duodenal peptic ulcer. It is a common cause of upper gastrointestinal bleeding and may present with haematemesis, coffee-ground vomiting, melaena, or haemodynamic instability.

Peptide

A short chain of amino acids linked by peptide bonds. Peptides can form parts of proteins or act independently as hormones, neurotransmitters, immune signals, or medicines.

Alternate Names:
Peptides

Peptide Biosynthesis

The process by which cells make peptides, short chains of amino acids, by linking amino acids according to genetic instructions. Some peptides act as hormones, neurotransmitters, or signals between cells.

Peptide Bond

The chemical link joining two amino acids. Repeated peptide bonds form short peptides and long proteins, which cells use for structure, chemical reactions, communication, transport, and many other functions.

Peptide Hormone

A hormone made of amino acids that binds a cell-surface receptor and regulates processes such as metabolism, growth, reproduction, stress, and fluid balance.

Peptide Metabolism

The body's production, breakdown, and use of peptides. These processes regulate signaling molecules, hormones, digestion, and protein turnover.

Peptide Transport

The movement of peptides into, out of, or within cells and tissues through transport proteins, vesicles, or other cellular mechanisms. It helps control peptide signaling, digestion, and removal from the body.

Peptide Yy

Peptide YY (PYY) is a hormone released mainly by cells in the intestine after eating. It helps reduce appetite and slow movement of food through the digestive tract and is being studied in relation to body weight and metabolism.

Peptidoglycan

A strong mesh-like material forming much of the bacterial cell wall. Some antibiotics kill bacteria by preventing them from making or repairing this protective layer.

Peptococcaceae

A family of anaerobic gram-positive cocci found in the human microbiota and sometimes associated with infection.

Peptococcus

A genus of anaerobic gram-positive cocci that can contribute to mixed infections, especially in damaged or poorly oxygenated tissue.

Peptococcus Niger

An anaerobic gram-positive coccus found in the human microbiota and rarely associated with mixed infection.

Peptoniphilus

A genus of anaerobic gram-positive cocci found on skin and mucosal surfaces that can cause opportunistic infection.

Peptoniphilus Harei

An anaerobic gram-positive coccus occasionally recovered from wounds, abscesses, or other clinical specimens. An anaerobic Gram-positive bacterium sometimes found in wounds and abscesses, where it may contribute to mixed infections.

Peptoniphilus Indolicus

An anaerobic gram-positive coccus found in the

genital and other microbiota that can occasionally contribute to mixed infection.

Peptostreptococcus

A group of anaerobic gram-positive cocci associated with dental, skin, abdominal, pelvic, and other mixed infections.

Peracetic Acid

A strong oxidizing disinfectant and sterilant used for equipment and surfaces; concentrated exposure irritates or burns skin, eyes, and airways.

Peracute

Peracute describes disease or a clinical event that develops extremely rapidly, often over minutes to hours, with little time for adaptation or diagnosis.

Percentile

A percentile indicates the percentage of a reference population with a value below a measurement, such as height, weight, or test score.

Perception

The brain's process of organizing and interpreting sensory information into an experience of objects, events, body sensations, or the environment.

Perceptual

Relating to the process of detecting and interpreting sensory information.

Perceptual Disorder

A clinically significant disturbance in the way sensory information is interpreted, including altered visual, auditory, tactile, or body perception.

Perceptual Distortion

An inaccurate or altered interpretation of a real sensory stimulus, which may occur with neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, drugs, migraine, seizures, or sensory impairment.

Perceptual Masking

Reduction in the ability to detect or identify one sensory stimulus because another stimulus overlaps it in time, space, or processing.

PERC Rule

A checklist used by emergency clinicians for people already judged very unlikely to have a blood clot in the lungs. If all criteria are reassuring, testing may be avoided; it is not suitable for home use or for people with a strong suspicion of clot.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonary Embolism Rule-out Criteria; PERC Score

Percussion

Physical examination in which the body surface is tapped and the resulting sound or vibration is interpreted to estimate underlying air, fluid, or solid tissue.

Percussion Myotonia

A muscle that stays contracted briefly after it is tapped. This may occur in myotonic dystrophy, myotonia congenita, and some other muscle disorders; the finding is interpreted with the rest of the examination.

Percussion Note

The sound heard when the chest is gently tapped during examination. A normal lung sounds hollow; a dull sound may suggest fluid or infection, while an unusually hollow sound may suggest excess air or a collapsed lung.

Percutaneous

Performed through the skin, usually using a needle, catheter, wire, or other instrument. This approach can diagnose or treat disease while avoiding a larger open operation, but bleeding and infection remain possible.

Percutaneous Biopsy

Removal of tissue through the skin using a needle or other instrument, often guided by ultrasound, CT, or another imaging method.

Percutaneous Closure

Closing a heart or blood-vessel opening using a device delivered through a catheter inserted through the skin. It can avoid open surgery in selected patients but has procedure-related risks.

Percutaneous Coronary Intervention

A procedure that guides a thin tube through a blood vessel to a narrowed heart artery, then widens it with a balloon and often supports it with a stent. It can restore blood flow during a heart attack or treat selected severe coronary disease.

Alternate Names:
PCI; Coronary Angioplasty With Stent Placement

Percutaneous Discectomy

Percutaneous discectomy removes or decompresses part of a herniated spinal disc through a small needle or incision.

Percutaneous Diskectomy

A minimally invasive procedure removing part of a herniated spinal disk through a small skin opening to relieve nerve pressure.

Percutaneous Drainage

Placement of a needle or catheter through the skin to drain a fluid collection or obstructed body space, often with imaging guidance.

Percutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation

Electrical stimulation delivered through the skin to reduce pain signals.

Alternate Names:
PENS

Percutaneous Endoscopic Gastrostomy

Placement of a feeding tube through the abdominal wall into the stomach using a camera passed through the mouth. It may provide long-term nutrition, fluids, or medicines when swallowing is unsafe or inadequate.

Percutaneous Kidney Procedures

Procedures performed through a small needle or tube passed through the skin into or near the kidney. They may obtain a biopsy, drain infection or urine, or remove stones; bleeding, infection, urine leakage, or injury to nearby organs are possible.

Percutaneous Nephrolithotomy

A procedure that removes a large or complex kidney stone through a small opening in the back. A narrow instrument reaches the kidney, breaks or removes the stone, and may leave a temporary drainage tube; bleeding, infection, and injury are possible.

Percutaneous Nephrolithotripsy

Percutaneous nephrolithotripsy removes or fragments kidney stones through a tract made through the skin into the kidney, usually for larger or complex stones.

Percutaneous Nephrostomy

A procedure that places a drainage tube through the skin of the back into the kidney. Urine drains into a bag when the normal path to the bladder is blocked or needs to be bypassed. It may be used for stones, tumors, infection, or a narrowed urine passage and requires follow-up care.

Alternate Names:
PCN; Nephrostomy Tube Placement; Percutaneous Renal Drainage

Percutaneous Transhepatic Cholangiogram

A percutaneous transhepatic cholangiogram uses a needle through the liver to inject contrast into bile ducts for imaging and may guide drainage or stent placement.

Percutaneous Transhepatic Cholangiography

PTC is imaging of the bile ducts after contrast is injected through a needle passed through the skin and liver; drainage or stenting may follow.

Percutaneous Transluminal Coronary

Angioplasty

Balloon-based treatment that widens a narrowed coronary artery, often followed by stent placement. A catheter procedure using balloon inflation to widen a narrowed coronary artery, sometimes followed by stent placement.

Alternate Names:
PTCA; Percutaneous Coronary Intervention

Percutaneous Umbilical Blood Sampling

A procedure that uses ultrasound to guide a needle into the umbilical cord and collect a fetal blood sample during pregnancy. It may investigate anemia, infection, or genetic problems and carries risks such as bleeding, infection, and pregnancy loss.

Perforant Pathway

A group of nerve fibers carrying information from a brain area involved in memory to the hippocampus. It helps the brain form and retrieve memories and can be affected in some dementias and seizure disorders.

Perforated Bowel

A perforated bowel is a hole through the intestinal wall allowing contents to leak into the abdomen, causing peritonitis and potentially life-threatening sepsis.

Perforated Eardrum

Alternate name; see *Ruptured Eardrum*.

Perforated Peptic Ulcer

A hole that an ulcer makes through the wall of the stomach or duodenum, the first part of the small intestine. Stomach or intestinal contents can leak into the abdomen and inflame or infect its lining (peritonitis), causing sudden, severe abdominal pain.

Alternate Names:
Perforated Ulcer

Perforating Folliculitis

A rare follicular disorder in which itchy keratotic papules develop around follicles and abnormal keratin is expelled through the epidermis. It is associated with chronic kidney disease, diabetes, and other systemic illness and may need treatment of both the skin and underlying disease.

Perforation

A hole or complete tear through the wall of an organ or tissue. It can release contents into surrounding spaces and cause severe infection, bleeding, or shock.

Perforation Of A Viscus

A hole through the wall of a hollow abdominal organ, such as the stomach, small intestine, or colon. Contents can leak into the abdomen and cause severe infection; ulcers, inflammation, poor blood flow, and injury are possible causes.

Performance

How effectively a person, organ, treatment, test, or system carries out a defined task. Examples include exercise performance, heart performance, test performance, and response to treatment.

Performance Anxiety

Anxiety about sexual performance that can interfere with sexual function.

Performance Status

A rating of how well a person can move, work, and perform daily activities while ill. Clinicians use it to estimate prognosis, decide whether some treatments are safe, and track change over time, especially during cancer care.

Perfusion

The flow of blood through the small vessels of a tissue or organ. Good perfusion supplies oxygen and nutrients and removes waste; poor perfusion can cause pain, weakness, tissue injury, or organ failure.

Perfusion Defect

An area receiving unusually little blood flow, identified by an imaging or function test. It may reflect a blocked artery, narrowed vessel, poor heart output, inflammation, or damaged tissue.

Perfusion Imaging

Imaging that shows how blood flows through an organ or tissue. It can help assess problems such as stroke, reduced heart blood flow, or tumor blood supply.

Perfusion PET

Positron-emission tomography that measures tissue blood flow using a suitable radioactive tracer. Cardiac perfusion PET can show reduced blood flow, viability, and sometimes the effects of treatment.

Perianal

Located around the anus; the term describes the skin, glands, pain, inflammation, abscesses, fistulas, and other findings in that region.

Perianal Abscess

A localized collection of pus near the anus caused by infected anal glands or surrounding tissue, producing severe throbbing pain, swelling, fever, and sometimes a fistula.

Perianal Glands

Small glands near the anus that contribute secretions to the local tissue; obstruction or infection can contribute to perianal abscesses and fistulas.

Perianal Streptococcal Cellulitis

A bacterial skin infection around the anus, usually caused by group A Streptococcus. It may cause bright-red skin, pain, itching, discharge, or pain during bowel movements.

Periapical Abscess

An acute or chronic localized collection of pus at the apex of a tooth's root, arising from pulpal infection and necrosis (usually due to untreated dental caries or trauma).

Periapical Granuloma

A chronic inflammatory lesion at the apex of a tooth, usually resulting from pulpal necrosis and persistent apical infection. It may be asymptomatic and is diagnosed through clinical, radiographic, and sometimes histopathologic assessment.

Periappendiceal

Periappendiceal means located around the appendix, as in inflammation, fluid, an abscess, or fat stranding near the appendiceal tissue.

Periarteritis Nodosa

An older name for polyarteritis nodosa, a necrotizing vasculitis of medium-sized arteries that can cause skin, nerve, muscle, kidney, and abdominal ischemic symptoms without typical glomerulonephritis.

Periarticular

Periarticular means located around a joint, including nearby tendons, bursae, ligaments, capsule, and soft tissues rather than the joint surface itself.

Pericardial

Relating to the pericardium, the thin two-layered sac surrounding the heart. A small amount of fluid between its layers allows the heart to beat smoothly, while excess fluid or inflammation can interfere with heart function.

Pericardial Cavity

The thin fluid-containing space between the layers of the sac surrounding the heart. A small amount of fluid lets the heart move smoothly; excess fluid or blood can press on the heart and impair its pumping.

Pericardial Effusion

Excess fluid in the sac surrounding the heart. Its effect depends on the volume and rate of accumulation and on how well the pericardium can stretch. A rapidly accumulating effusion, even a small one, can impair heart filling and cause cardiac tamponade, while a slowly developing effusion may cause no symptoms.

Pericardial Effusion Etiology

Fluid around the heart may result from infection, cancer, kidney failure, low thyroid activity, autoimmune disease, heart injury, surgery, radiation, trauma, or medicines. Tests and the person's history

help identify the cause.

Pericardial Fluid Analysis

Laboratory examination of fluid removed from the pericardial space, usually during pericardiocentesis. Cell counts, chemistry, cytology, cultures, and targeted tests help investigate infection, cancer, tuberculosis, inflammation, or bleeding; findings are interpreted with the clinical context.

Pericardial Fluid Culture

A microbiologic culture of fluid from the pericardial space to identify bacteria, fungi, or other organisms in suspected infectious pericarditis.

Pericardial Fluid Gram Stain

A microscopic stain of pericardial fluid that can rapidly suggest bacterial organisms, although a negative result does not exclude infection.

Pericardial Friction Rub

A scratchy or grating sound heard when the inflamed layers around the heart rub together. It can support a diagnosis of acute pericarditis, especially when heard along the left side of the breastbone, but it may come and go and is not present in every case.

Pericardial Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Pericarditis*.

Pericardial Knock

An extra early heart sound caused when a stiff, scarred sac around the heart suddenly stops the heart from filling. It may suggest constrictive pericarditis and is considered with other examination and test findings.

Pericardial Knock Sound

An early diastolic, high-pitched, sharp, knocking extra heart sound heard on auscultation in patients with chronic constrictive pericarditis. Occurs 0.08 to 0.12 seconds after aortic valve closure (S_2), earlier than a standard third heart sound (S_3), caused by the sudden abrupt cessation of ventricular filling when the expanding ventricular myocardium collides with the rigid, non-compliant, calcified pericardium.

Alternate Names:
Pericardial Knock; Constrictive Knock Sound

Pericardial Mesothelioma

A rare malignant tumor arising from the mesothelial lining around the heart, which can cause effusion, constriction, or impaired cardiac filling.

Pericardial Metastases

Cancer that has spread to the sac around the heart from another part of the body. It may cause inflammation, fluid or blood around the heart, breathlessness, chest discomfort, or impaired heart filling.

Pericardial Rub

Alternate name; see *Pericardial Friction Rub*.

Pericardial Stripping

Surgery to remove part or most of the thickened or scarred sac around the heart. It may relieve constrictive pericarditis, in which the stiff sac prevents the heart from filling normally; bleeding, rhythm problems, and other major surgical risks are possible.

Pericardial Tamponade

Alternate name; see *Cardiac Tamponade*.

Pericardial Wall

The layered tissue forming the protective sac around the heart. Its inner surfaces produce a small amount of lubricating fluid that lets the heart beat with little friction.

Pericardial Window

An operation that creates an opening in the sac around the heart so extra fluid can drain into a nearby space and be absorbed. It may prevent repeated fluid buildup and allow a tissue sample to be taken.

Alternate Names:
Subxiphoid Pericardiostomy; Pleuropericardial Window; Pericardiostomy

Pericardiectomy

Surgery to remove part or most of the sac around the heart when thickening or scarring prevents the heart from filling normally. It is major surgery and may improve constrictive pericarditis but carries bleeding and other serious risks.

Pericardiocentesis

A needle or catheter is used to remove fluid or blood from the sac around the heart, usually to relieve dangerous pressure or investigate an effusion. Imaging guidance improves safety, but bleeding, abnormal rhythm, organ injury, or infection can occur.

Pericardiostomy

A surgical opening made in the pericardium to drain fluid or prevent recurrent accumulation around the heart.

Pericarditis

Inflammation of the sac around the heart. It often causes sharp chest pain that worsens with deep breathing or lying down and improves when sitting up and leaning forward. It may be caused by infections, autoimmune diseases, heart injury, kidney disease, cancer, or some medicines. Severe cases can cause fluid buildup around the heart.

Alternate Names:
Pericardial Sac Inflammation

Pericardium

The sac around the heart and the roots of the major blood vessels. It has an outer fibrous layer and an inner serous membrane. The serous membrane folds into a layer lining the sac and a layer covering the heart. A small amount of fluid between these layers reduces friction as the heart beats.

Perichondritis

Inflammation or infection of the tissue covering cartilage, often affecting the outer ear after an injury or piercing. It can cause redness, swelling, and pain and may damage the ear's shape.

Perichondritis Of The Ear

Infection or inflammation of the auricular perichondrium, often after trauma, piercing, or surgery. Pseudomonas aeruginosa is an important cause; delayed treatment can produce cartilage necrosis and permanent deformity.

Perichondrium

A tough layer of tissue surrounding most cartilage. It supplies nutrients, contains cells that help cartilage grow and repair, and can become inflamed or infected, especially around the outer ear.

Pericoronitis

Infection or swelling of the gum around a tooth that has only partly come through, often a wisdom tooth. Trapped food and bacteria can cause pain, swelling, fever, or trouble opening the mouth. The infection can sometimes spread.

Pericytes

Pericytes are contractile support cells wrapped around small blood vessels that help regulate capillary stability, blood flow, repair, and the blood-brain barrier.

Periductal Mastitis

Recurrent inflammation around the breast ducts beneath the nipple, often associated with duct blockage and smoking. It may cause tenderness, nipple retraction, or recurrent abscesses and a draining channel near the areola.

Perifolliculitis Capitis Abscedens et Suffodiens

A severe chronic scalp folliculitis, also called dissecting cellulitis, in which deep nodules, abscesses, and interconnected tunnels cause purulent drainage and permanent scarring alopecia. It is part of the follicular-occlusion spectrum and may coexist with acne conglobata or pilonidal disease.

Alternate Names:
Dissecting Cellulitis

Peri-Implantitis

Inflammation around a dental implant with progressive loss of the supporting bone. It may cause bleeding, swelling, pus, pain, or implant looseness and requires dental assessment.

Perilymph

Fluid in the bony labyrinth of the inner ear that surrounds the membranous labyrinth and helps transmit sound and balance signals.

Perilymphatic Fistula

An abnormal leak between the fluid spaces of the inner ear and the middle ear, often after injury, pressure changes, or surgery. It may cause dizziness, hearing loss, ringing, or symptoms triggered by sound or pressure.

Perimenopausal

Perimenopausal describes the years of hormonal and menstrual transition before and around menopause, when cycles, bleeding, hot flashes, sleep, and fertility may change.

Perimenopause

The transition toward menopause, when ovarian hormone levels change and menstrual periods often become irregular. The term may include the first 12 months after the final menstrual period. Menopause is confirmed retrospectively after 12 consecutive months without a period, when other causes are excluded.

Perimetry

A test that measures the full field of vision, including central and side vision. It helps detect and monitor problems such as glaucoma, optic-nerve disease, retinal disease, and disorders affecting the visual pathways in the brain.

Perimysium

A layer of connective tissue that surrounds groups of muscle fibers, forming bundles called fascicles. It carries small blood vessels and nerves within the muscle.

Perinatal

Perinatal refers to the period around birth, conventionally including late pregnancy and the first days or weeks after delivery depending on the definition used.

Perinatal Asphyxia

Impaired gas exchange around labor and delivery that, if persistent, can cause low blood oxygen, raised carbon dioxide, and reduced oxygen delivery to tissues. Use the term when there is evidence of impaired gas exchange; newborn neurologic dysfunction is described as neonatal encephalopathy, and hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy specifies a hypoxic-ischemic cause.

Perinatal Death

Death of a fetus or newborn during the late pregnancy, birth, or early newborn period; the exact time range varies by definition.

Perinatal Psychiatry

The subspecialty focused on psychiatric disorders during pregnancy and the postpartum period. Common conditions include perinatal depression, perinatal anxiety, perinatal OCD, and postpartum psychosis. Medication selection must balance maternal mental health with fetal or neonatal exposure risks.

Perinatal Transmission

Transmission of an infection or condition from mother to infant during pregnancy, labor, delivery, or breastfeeding, as with HIV, hepatitis B, syphilis, or certain genetic and congenital disorders.

Perinatologist

A perinatologist is an obstetrician specializing in high-risk pregnancy, fetal medicine, prenatal diagnosis, and complications affecting the pregnant person or fetus.

Perindopril

Perindopril is an ACE inhibitor used for high blood pressure and cardiovascular risk reduction; it can cause cough, high potassium, or rarely angioedema.

Perineal

Relating to the area between the external genitals and anus, which can be affected by injury or infection.

Perineal Hemostat

A clamp used during procedures to compress a blood vessel or hold tissue and control bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Perineal Hemostatic Clamp; Pelvic Bleeding Forceps

Perineal Laceration

Tearing of the perineal tissues during vaginal delivery. The injury is graded by depth: it may involve skin, perineal muscle, the anal sphincter, or the rectal mucosa.

Perineal Laceration Classification

A system grading tears during childbirth by depth: first degree affects skin, second degree also affects muscle, third degree involves the anal-control muscle, and fourth degree extends into the rectum. Accurate examination and repair reduce later pain and bowel-control problems.

Perineal Needle Holder

A surgical instrument used to hold and guide a suture needle while repairing tissues of the perineum. Its locking handle allows controlled needle placement and helps protect the surgeon's hands.

Alternate Names:
Perineorrhaphy Needle Holder; Perineal Needle Holder

Perineal Protection

Measures used during the pushing stage of childbirth to reduce severe tearing of the tissue between the vagina and anus. They may include controlled delivery of the baby's head, support of the perineum, a warm compress, and a selective approach to episiotomy.

Perineal Suture

A thread or strand of material used to approximate tissues (bring wound edges together) and hold them in place until healing occurs. See Suture.

Alternate Names:
Perineal Suture; Perineorrhaphy Suture

Perineal Tear

A split in the tissue between the vagina and anus during vaginal birth. First-degree tears affect skin, second-degree tears reach muscle, third-degree tears involve the anal-control muscle, and fourth-degree tears extend into the rectum; severe tears need careful repair and follow-up.

Perineum

The area between the external genitalia and the anus. It contains skin, muscles, nerves, and connective tissue and may be affected by injury, infection, childbirth, or surgery.

Perineural

Perineural means around a nerve; the term may describe normal connective tissue, inflammation, tumor spread, or imaging findings surrounding a nerve.

Perineuronal Satellitosis

A microscopic pattern in which supporting brain cells cluster around a nerve cell. It can occur in some brain tumors, inflammation, or reactive changes and has meaning only with the surrounding tissue findings.

Perinuclear Space

The narrow space between the two membranes surrounding a cell nucleus. It connects with part of the cell's internal membrane network and helps form the nuclear envelope.

Periodic Abstinence

Periodic abstinence is avoiding intercourse during estimated fertile days to reduce pregnancy likelihood; cycle timing is imperfect and does not prevent infections.

Periodic Acid

A chemical used to stain tissue samples. In the

periodic-acid–Schiff test, it helps highlight sugars, mucus, certain fungi, and supporting membranes so they can be seen under a microscope.

Periodic Breathing

Repeated cycles of shallow or absent breaths followed by deeper breaths. It can occur normally for short periods in some infants or during sleep, but persistent episodes may reflect a brain, heart, or lung disorder.

Periodic Limb Movement Disorder

Repeated involuntary limb movements during sleep that may disrupt rest.

Alternate Names:
PLMD; Periodic Leg Movements in Sleep; Nocturnal Myoclonus

Periodic Limb Movement Sleep Disorder

Alternate name; see *Periodic Limb Movement Disorder*.

Periodic Paralysis Syndrome

Periodic paralysis syndromes are rare inherited or acquired disorders causing episodic muscle weakness associated with abnormal potassium handling or thyroid disease. Attacks may follow rest after exercise, meals, or stress; ECG, potassium testing, and genetic or endocrine evaluation guide care.

Periodontal Abscess

A localized accumulation of pus within periodontal tissues, commonly associated with a periodontal pocket, foreign material, or impaired drainage. It may cause pain, swelling, suppuration, tooth mobility, and systemic symptoms and requires urgent dental assessment.

Periodontal Cyst

A periodontal cyst is a fluid-filled epithelial-lined lesion near the tooth-supporting tissues, with effects ranging from incidental discovery to local bone destruction.

Periodontal Disease

Infection or inflammation of the tissues supporting teeth, including gums and jawbone. It can cause bleeding, swelling, bad breath, loose teeth, bone loss, and tooth loss, but treatment can slow progression.

Periodontal Dressing

A protective material placed over the gums after selected dental or periodontal procedures. It can protect the surgical area while it heals and reduce irritation; loosening, pain, odor, or swelling can occur with local complications.

Periodontal Flap Surgery

Dental surgery in which the gum is gently lifted so a clinician can clean infection and deposits below the gumline and, when needed, reshape accessible bone before replacing the gum.

Periodontal Graft

Tissue placed around a tooth to cover an exposed root, thicken the gum, or repair gum loss. The tissue may come from the person's mouth, a donor, or a processed substitute.

Alternate Names:
Periodontal Soft Tissue Graft; Gingival Graft

Periodontal Ligament

Strong tissue fibers that attach a tooth's root to the surrounding jawbone. They cushion chewing forces, help the body sense pressure on the tooth, and can become inflamed or damaged in gum disease or grinding.

Periodontal Pocket

An abnormally deep space between a tooth and the surrounding gum caused by loss of attachment. Plaque can collect there, leading to bleeding, infection, bone loss, loose teeth, and eventual tooth loss.

Periodontal Probing

A dentist gently measures the space between the gum and tooth with a marked instrument. Deeper spaces, bleeding, and loss of support can indicate

gum disease; measurements help assess severity and monitor treatment.

Periodontics

The dental specialty focused on preventing, diagnosing, and treating gum disease and tissues supporting the teeth.

Periodontist

A periodontist is a dentist specializing in prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of gum disease and supporting tissues, including periodontal surgery and implants.

Periodontitis

Long-lasting gum disease in which bacteria in plaque damage the gums and bone that hold teeth in place. It can cause bleeding gums, gums that pull away from teeth, loose teeth, bad breath, and tooth loss. Its severity and course vary.

Alternate Names:
Pyorrhea; Periodontal Disease; Periodontal Gum Disease; Advanced Gum Disease

Periodontium

The tissues that hold and support a tooth, including gums, ligament, root covering, and jawbone. Disease of these tissues can cause bleeding, gum recession, loose teeth, bone loss, and tooth loss.

Periodontium Disease

Disease of the tissues supporting the teeth, including gingiva, periodontal ligament, cementum, and alveolar bone; periodontitis can cause attachment loss and tooth loss.

Perionychium

The skin and soft tissue surrounding a fingernail or toenail, including the nail folds and nearby cuticle; infection or inflammation causes paronychia.

Perioperative

Perioperative means relating to the period before, during, and after an operation, including preparation, anesthesia, recovery, and complication prevention.

Perioral Dermatitis

A papulopustular eruption around the mouth, sparing the vermilion border. It is more common in young women and associated with topical corticosteroid use. Other triggers include fluoridated toothpaste, cosmetics, and inhaler steroids.

Periorbita

The periosteum covering the bones of the eye socket. It is continuous with nearby cranial and facial periosteum and provides an attachment surface for orbital structures.

Periorbital

Located around the eye socket or eyelids. Periorbital swelling may result from injury, allergy, infection, or fluid retention.

Periorbital Cellulitis

A bacterial infection of the eyelid and tissues around the eye that causes redness, swelling, and tenderness. Orbital cellulitis is a deeper infection that can threaten vision and spread to the brain.

Periorbital Edema

Swelling of the tissues around the eye, caused by allergy, infection, trauma, venous or lymphatic congestion, kidney disease, thyroid eye disease, or other systemic conditions.

Periorbital Infection

Infection of the tissues around the eye; it can cause swelling and redness. Orbital cellulitis is a deeper form that threatens vision.

Periorbital Purpura

Nonblanching red-purple spots or patches caused by bleeding into the skin around the eyelids. Causes include trauma and bleeding disorders; spontaneous or easily induced periorbital purpura is a characteristic clue to immunoglobulin light-chain (AL) amyloidosis, but is not specific to it.

Periosteal Osteosarcoma

A cancerous bone tumor that develops beneath the thin tissue covering a bone, usually along the shaft of a long bone. It often makes cartilage and causes pain or swelling, requiring specialist cancer treatment.

Periosteal Reaction

The non-specific radiographic and histological response of the periosteum to cortical bone irritation, injury, infection, or underlying malignancy, manifesting as solid, laminated ("onion-skin"), spicular ("sunburst"), or Codman triangle bone formation.

Periosteum

A blood-vessel-rich, pain-sensitive tissue layer covering the outer surface of bone, except where joint cartilage covers it. It supplies nutrients, supports repair, and provides attachment for tendons and ligaments.

Periostitis

Inflammation of the periosteum, the pain-sensitive tissue covering the outer surface of bone. It may cause localized bone pain, tenderness, or swelling and can result from repeated stress, infection, injury, or another disease.

Peripancreatic Malignancy

Cancer involving the tissues around the pancreas, either by spreading from the pancreas or from another organ. It may cause abdominal or back pain, weight loss, jaundice, or newly developed diabetes and usually needs detailed imaging and specialist care.

Peripartum

Relating to the period around childbirth, including late pregnancy, labor, delivery, and the early weeks after birth. Clinicians may use a more specific time range for a particular condition or study.

Peripartum Cardiomyopathy

A usually dilated cardiomyopathy that develops toward the end of pregnancy or during the postpartum period and may cause systolic heart failure. Features can include breathlessness, difficulty lying flat, swelling, fatigue, or chest discomfort.

Alternate Names:
PPCM; Pregnancy-Associated Cardiomyopathy

Peripartum Cardiomyopathy Prognosis

Recovery of ventricular function varies widely. Prognosis is influenced by the initial ejection fraction, ventricular size, symptoms, treatment, complications, and follow-up; persistent dysfunction requires ongoing cardiac care.

Peripartum (Postpartum) Cardiomyopathy (PPCM)

A form of heart-muscle failure developing toward the end of pregnancy or in the months after delivery. It may cause breathlessness, orthopnea, swelling, chest discomfort, palpitations, or fatigue and can progress to severe heart failure; treatment is adapted to pregnancy or breastfeeding.

Peripheral

Peripheral means away from the center or central nervous system; in clinical use it may describe nerves, vessels, lesions, circulation, or symptoms outside the brain, spinal cord, or central structures.

Peripheral Angioplasty

A percutaneous vascular intervention that dilates stenosed or occluded peripheral arteries—primarily in the lower extremities, renal arteries, or carotid vessels—using balloon dilation and optional stent placement.

Alternate Names:
PTA; Peripheral Arterial Angioplasty

Peripheral Artery Disease

Narrowing of arteries supplying the limbs, usually caused by atherosclerosis. It may cause exertional leg pain relieved by rest, reduced pulses, nonhealing wounds, or chronic limb-threatening ischemia, a severe reduction in blood flow associated with persistent pain or tissue loss. Also called peripheral arterial disease.

Alternate Names:
PAD; Peripheral Arterial Occlusive Disease; PAOD

Peripheral Blood

Peripheral blood is blood obtained from a vein or capillary rather than directly from an organ or marrow, used for counts, smears, chemistry, and other testing.

Peripheral Blood Smear

Microscopic examination of stained blood spread on a slide. It shows the size, shape, and appearance of red cells, white cells, and platelets and can help investigate anemia, infection, and blood disorders.

Peripheral Blood Stem Cells

Immature blood-forming cells collected from the bloodstream after medicines encourage them to leave the bone marrow. They can be returned to the same person or given to another person to rebuild blood production after intensive treatment.

Peripheral Cyanosis

Blue or gray-blue color in the fingers, toes, hands, or feet, usually because blood flow there is low or the body is taking more oxygen from the blood. The lips and tongue usually keep their normal color; blue lips or tongue may signal low oxygen throughout the body.

Peripheral Edema

Swelling due to accumulation of fluid in the interstitial space of the limbs, most commonly the lower extremities.

Peripheral Ischemia

Inadequate arterial blood flow to an arm, leg, digit, or other peripheral tissue, causing pain, pallor, coolness, weak pulses, numbness, ulcers, or tissue loss.

Peripherally Inserted Central Catheter

A long, flexible catheter inserted into the basilic or cephalic vein and advanced so the tip sits in the superior vena cava. Inserted at the bedside, often by a specialized PICC nurse, with ultrasound and ECG or X-ray confirmation. Indications: long-term IV antibiotics (>2 weeks), TPN, chemotherapy, and frequent blood draws.

Peripheral Nerve

A nerve outside the brain and spinal cord that carries motor, sensory, and autonomic signals between the central nervous system and the rest of the body.

Peripheral Nerve Blocks

Injections of local anesthetic near a nerve or group of nerves to numb a specific area and reduce pain during or after a procedure. Ultrasound guidance may improve accuracy and safety.

Peripheral Nerve Injuries

Damage to nerves outside the brain and spinal cord caused by trauma, compression, stretching, disease, or toxins. It may cause pain, numbness, weakness, or loss of function; recovery depends on the severity and location of the injury.

Peripheral Nerve Tumors

Growths arising from or around nerves outside the brain and spinal cord; they may be benign or cancerous.

Peripheral Nervous System

All nerves outside the brain and spinal cord. It carries messages between the central nervous system and the skin, muscles, organs, and glands, controlling movement, sensation, and automatic functions such as heartbeat and digestion.

Peripheral Neuritis

Alternate name; see *Peripheral Neuropathy*.

Peripheral Neurofibromatosis

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

Peripheral Neuropathy

Damage or dysfunction of nerves outside the brain and spinal cord. It may cause burning pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or problems with sweating and other automatic body functions, often beginning in the feet or hands.

Alternate Names:
Peripheral Nerve Damage

Peripheral Oedema

Alternate spelling of Peripheral Edema; swelling caused by excess interstitial fluid, usually in the limbs.

Peripheral Vascular Disease

A broad term for disease of blood vessels outside the heart and brain. It is often used to mean peripheral artery disease, in which narrowed leg arteries cause pain with walking, coldness, wounds that heal slowly, or tissue loss; the vessel involved should be specified because venous disorders are different.

Alternate Names:
PVD; Peripheral Angiopathy

Peripheral Vision

The parts of the visual field seen away from the direct line of sight. Loss can result from eye disease, nerve damage, brain injury, or glaucoma and may increase falls or collisions.

Alternate Names:
Side Vision

Periplasm

The periplasm is the space between the inner and outer membranes of Gram-negative bacteria, containing enzymes, transport proteins, and structural components.

Periprosthetic Joint Infection

Infection involving an artificial joint and nearby tissues. It may cause persistent pain, swelling, drainage, fever, or loosening. Diagnosis uses examination, blood tests, joint-fluid testing, cultures, and imaging; treatment may require antibiotics and surgery.

Perirenal Abscess

A perirenal abscess is a collection of pus around the kidney, usually from spread of a urinary or kidney infection, causing fever, flank pain, and possible sepsis.

Perirenal Extramedullary Hematopoiesis

Production of blood cells in tissue around the kidney instead of mainly in the bone marrow. It is an unusual response to severe long-term anemia or bone-marrow disease and may appear as masses on imaging.

Perirenal Hematoma

A collection of blood around the kidney, usually caused by trauma, a bleeding lesion, a procedure, or anticoagulation.

Peristalsis

Peristalsis is coordinated, wave-like contraction of smooth muscle that propels food, fluid, or other contents through the gastrointestinal tract and some ducts.

Peritoneal

Peritoneal means relating to the peritoneum, the thin membrane lining the abdominal cavity and covering many abdominal organs.

Peritoneal Cancer

Cancer arising from or involving the peritoneum, the membrane lining the abdominal cavity and covering many abdominal organs. It may be primary or metastatic and can cause abdominal swelling, pain, bowel symptoms, or ascites; imaging, fluid analysis, and tissue diagnosis help determine the origin.

Peritoneal Carcinomatosis

Multiple cancer deposits on the peritoneum, the lining of the abdominal cavity and its organs, after cancer spreads there from another site. Common sources include ovarian, colorectal, stomach, pancreatic, and appendiceal cancers. It can cause abdominal fluid buildup, pain, or bowel obstruction; it is distinct from a cancer that begins in the peritoneum.

Peritoneal Cavity

The narrow space inside the abdominal lining around the abdominal and pelvic organs. A small amount of fluid normally lubricates it; blood, pus, excess fluid, or cancer cells can collect there during disease.

Peritoneal Coccidioidomycosis

Rare spread of Coccidioides fungi to the abdominal lining, causing inflammation called coccidioidal peritonitis. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea, or fluid buildup and can resemble abdominal cancer or tuberculosis on scans. Diagnosis is based on clinical findings with blood tests and, when needed, fluid or tissue testing.

Peritoneal Dialysis

A dialysis method that uses the peritoneum, the lining of the abdomen, as a semipermeable membrane. Waste and salts diffuse from blood into dialysis fluid placed in the abdominal cavity; glucose in the fluid creates an osmotic gradient that draws out excess water. The fluid is then drained and replaced. Peritonitis is a possible complication.

Peritoneal Dialysis-Associated Peritonitis

Infection or inflammation of the abdominal lining during peritoneal dialysis, usually related to contamination of the dialysis catheter or fluid. It may cause cloudy drainage, abdominal pain, fever, or nausea.

Peritoneal Dialysis Catheter

A soft tube placed through the abdominal wall into the abdominal cavity for dialysis. Dialysis fluid enters and leaves through it to remove waste and extra water; infection, blockage, leakage, or displacement can occur.

Peritoneal Diseases

Disorders affecting the thin lining of the abdomen, including infection, inflammation, cancer, bleeding, scar tissue, or abnormal fluid buildup. Symptoms depend on the cause and may include abdominal pain, swelling, fever, or vomiting.

Peritoneal Fluid

The small amount of slippery fluid normally present inside the abdominal cavity. Excess fluid, blood, pus, or cancer cells can collect there and may cause swelling, pain, infection, or other signs of abdominal disease.

Peritoneal Fluid Analysis

Laboratory testing of fluid collected from the abdominal cavity. Cell counts, protein, albumin, cultures, and other tests help determine whether the fluid is caused by liver disease, infection, cancer, bleeding, or another problem.

Peritoneal Fluid Culture

Culture of ascitic fluid to detect microorganisms, particularly in suspected spontaneous bacterial peritonitis or secondary peritoneal infection.

Peritoneal Infection

Infection of the lining of the abdominal cavity, often called peritonitis. Causes include a ruptured appendix or bowel, abdominal surgery, pelvic infection, or contamination during dialysis. Severe abdominal pain, fever, vomiting, or a rigid abdomen can occur with severe infection.

Alternate Names:
Peritonitis

Peritoneal Lavage

Washing or sampling the abdominal cavity with sterile fluid. It was once used more often to detect internal bleeding or intestinal contents after injury; imaging and other tests now commonly provide this information.

Peritoneal Necrosis

Death of peritoneal tissue caused by ischemia, severe infection, inflammation, trauma, or tumor, potentially leading to peritonitis, adhesions, sepsis, or organ failure.

Peritoneal Sac

The space formed by the abdominal lining around the abdominal and pelvic organs. It normally contains only a small amount of lubricating fluid, but blood, pus, excess fluid, or cancer can collect there.

Peritoneum

A thin, slippery lining that covers the inside of the abdomen and many abdominal organs. It allows organs to move smoothly; inflammation, infection,

bleeding, fluid, or cancer in this lining can cause severe abdominal symptoms.

Peritoneum Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the lining of the abdominal cavity. It may begin there or spread from cancer in another organ and can cause abdominal pain, swelling, fluid buildup, or bowel blockage.

Peritonitis

Infection or inflammation of the thin tissue that lines the inside of the abdomen and covers most of its organs. Causes include a hole in the stomach or bowel, appendicitis, injury, surgery, or infection in fluid in the abdomen. It can cause severe belly pain, tenderness, swelling, fever, nausea, or vomiting. It is an emergency because it can lead to sepsis, a severe body-wide response to infection, or shock.

Peritonitis In PD

Infection of the abdominal lining in a person receiving peritoneal dialysis. Cloudy drainage, abdominal pain, fever, nausea, or feeling unwell may occur; treatment includes antibiotics, and severe or repeated infection may lead to catheter removal.

Peritonsillar Abscess

A pocket of pus beside a tonsil, usually after a throat infection. It can cause severe pain on one side of the throat, fever, a thick-sounding voice, drooling, or trouble opening the mouth or breathing.

Periumbilical Erythema Migrans

An expanding erythema migrans rash centered around the navel, usually at the site of a bite from a Borrelia-infected tick. It is a presentation of early Lyme borreliosis. The rash may be uniformly red or ring-shaped, with or without central clearing; a bull's-eye pattern is not required.

Periungual Fibroma

A noncancerous, firm growth arising beside or beneath a fingernail or toenail. It may distort the nail and can occur alone or as one of several skin findings in tuberous sclerosis complex.

Periurethral

Located around the urethra, the tube that carries urine out of the body. The term may describe glands, infection, an abscess, a urethral diverticulum, or tissue and treatments used for urinary leakage.

Periventricular Leukomalacia

Injury to the brain's developing nerve fibers near its fluid-filled spaces, most often in premature infants. It may later affect movement, muscle tone, vision, learning, or development and is associated with cerebral palsy.

Perivitelline Space

The perivitelline space is the narrow region between an egg's plasma membrane and surrounding vitelline or zona material, important in fertilization and early development.

Perleche

Inflammation, soreness, and cracking at one or both corners of the mouth. Saliva, ill-fitting dentures, yeast or bacterial infection, skin irritation, and iron or vitamin shortages can contribute; treatment depends on the cause and keeping the area dry.

Permanent Teeth

The adult set of teeth that replaces the deciduous teeth.

Permease

A permease is a membrane transport protein that facilitates movement of a specific molecule or ion across a cell membrane.

Permethrin

A skin-applied medicine that kills scabies mites and head lice. It is usually applied as directed and washed off later; itching may continue briefly after treatment even when parasites are gone.

Permissive Hypercapnia

A ventilator approach that allows carbon dioxide in the blood to remain above normal so that gentler pressures and smaller breaths can protect injured

lungs. It is used selectively and requires close monitoring because excessive acidity or carbon dioxide can be harmful.

Pernicious Anaemia

A form of vitamin B12 deficiency caused by immune damage to stomach cells needed for B12 absorption. It can cause anemia, tiredness, sore tongue, numbness, balance problems, and nerve damage.

Pernicious Anemia

Anemia caused by vitamin B12 deficiency when the body lacks intrinsic factor, a stomach protein needed to absorb B12. This often results from immune damage to the stomach lining and can also affect the nerves.

Alternate Names:
Biermer Disease; Addisonian Anemia

Pernio

Alternate name; see *Chilblain*.

Peroneal

Relating to the fibula or the muscles and nerve on the outer side of the lower leg.

Peroneal Muscular Atrophy

Alternate name; see *Charcot-Marie-Tooth Disease*.

Peroneal Nerve

The common fibular nerve, a branch of the sciatic nerve that winds around the fibular neck and supplies sensation and muscles responsible for ankle dorsiflexion and eversion.

Peroneal Nerve Palsy

A peripheral lower motor neuropathy caused by trauma or compression of the common fibular (peroneal) nerve as it courses superficially around the neck of the fibula, presenting with foot drop (loss of ankle dorsiflexion and eversion) and sensory numbness over the anterolateral lower leg and dorsum of the foot.

Alternate Names:
Common Fibular Nerve Palsy; Foot Drop Palsy

Peroneal Tendinitis

Irritation or inflammation of the tendons along the outer side of the ankle and foot. It can cause pain or swelling that worsens with walking or turning the foot; see also *Peroneal Tendon Syndromes*.

Peroneal Tendon Syndromes

Disorders of the peroneal tendons, including tendinopathy, subluxation, and tears, usually causing pain or swelling behind the outer ankle and sometimes ankle instability. They may follow overuse, an inversion injury, or structural abnormalities.

Posterior Tibial Tendon Dysfunction

Weakness, stretching, or damage of the tendon that helps support the arch along the inside of the ankle and foot. It can cause inner-ankle pain and a gradually flattening arch, sometimes called adult-acquired flatfoot.

Alternate Names:
PTTD

Peroxidase

An enzyme that uses hydrogen peroxide or another peroxide to oxidize a substrate; thyroid peroxidase is essential for thyroid-hormone synthesis.

Peroxisomal Disorder

An inherited condition in which small cell structures that process certain fats do not form or work properly. It may affect the brain, nerves, liver, eyes, hearing, bones, or development.

Peroxisome

A small structure inside a cell that breaks down certain fats and harmful substances. It also helps control hydrogen peroxide and makes substances needed for cell membranes and nerve function.

Peroxisome Proliferation

An increase in the number or size of peroxisomes, small cell structures that process certain fats and harmful chemicals. It can be triggered by some medicines, chemicals, hormones, or metabolic conditions and may alter cell function.

Perphenazine

A first-generation (typical) phenothiazine antipsychotic used for schizophrenia and, in some settings, severe nausea or vomiting. Adverse effects can include sedation, orthostatic hypotension, extrapyramidal symptoms, tardive dyskinesia, and neuroleptic malignant syndrome.

Perseveration

Involuntary repetition of a word, idea, movement, or response after the appropriate stimulus has changed, associated with frontal or basal-ganglia disease, aphasia, delirium, or psychiatric illness.

Persistent Asthma

Asthma symptoms or airway narrowing that occur regularly rather than only occasionally and usually require ongoing controller treatment. Severity is judged by symptoms, night waking, reliever use, lung function, and activity limits; treatment is adjusted over time.

Persistent Cloaca

Persistent cloaca is a congenital malformation in which the rectum, vagina, and urinary tract join into one channel, requiring specialist evaluation and reconstructive care.

Persistent Depressive Disorder

A long-lasting depressive disorder with depressed mood or irritability for at least two years in adults or one year in children and adolescents. Other symptoms may include low energy, low self-esteem, sleep or appetite changes, poor concentration, or hopelessness.

Alternate Names:
Dysthymia; Dysthymic Disorder; PDD

Persistent Depressive Disorder (Dysthymia)

Alternate name; see *Persistent Depressive Disorder*.

Persistent Fetal Vasculature

Persistence after birth of fetal blood vessels that normally regress before or soon after birth. It usually affects one eye and may cause a small eye, cataract, abnormal pupil reflection, retinal changes, or reduced vision.

Persistent Generalized Lymphadenopathy

Enlarged lymph nodes in at least two areas outside the groin that persist for three months or longer. It can occur with HIV infection but also has many other causes, including infections, medicines, and immune or blood disorders; evaluation depends on the clinical findings.

Alternate Names:
PGL

Persistent Pulmonary Hypertension Of The Newborn

Failure of the normal fall in pulmonary vascular resistance after birth, causing right-to-left shunting and hypoxaemia. Treatment involves neonatal respiratory and circulatory support.

Persistent Pupillary Membranes

Strands left from a temporary membrane that covered the developing eye before birth. They may cross the pupil and are usually harmless, but dense strands can interfere with vision and may be treated surgically.

Persistent Vegetative State

An older term for a prolonged disorder of consciousness in which a person has periods of wakefulness but no clear signs of awareness. The preferred term is *unresponsive wakefulness syndrome*; diagnosis requires careful specialist assessment over time.

Alternate Names:
PVS; Unresponsive Wakefulness Syndrome

Personal Emergency Response System

A wearable or nearby device that lets a person summon help during an emergency.

Alternate Names:
PERS; Medical Alert System

Personality

Personality is the relatively enduring pattern of

thoughts, emotions, motivations, and behaviors through which a person experiences and responds to the world.

Personality Change

Personality change is a new or marked alteration in behavior, emotional responses, judgment, or interpersonal style, which may reflect neurologic disease, psychiatric illness, substances, or medical conditions.

Personality Disorder

An enduring, inflexible, and pervasive pattern of inner experience and behavior that deviates markedly from cultural expectations, leads to significant distress or functional impairment, and has an onset traceable to adolescence or early adulthood. DSM-5 categorizes personality disorders into three clusters: Cluster A (paranoid, schizoid, schizotypal—odd/eccentric), Cluster B (antisocial, borderline, histrionic, narcissistic—dramatic/emotional/erratic), and Cluster C (avoidant, dependent, obsessive-compulsive—anxious/fearful). Treatment primarily utilizes evidence-based psychotherapies (e.g., dialectical behavior therapy, mentalization-based therapy).

Alternate Names:
Personality Disorders

Personality Disorders

Plural form; see *Personality Disorder*.

Personality Test

A psychological assessment using structured questions or stimuli to describe enduring traits, patterns, or possible personality pathology; results require validated instruments and clinical interpretation.

Personalized Medicine

Healthcare that uses a person's genes, biological measurements, environment, and lifestyle to guide prevention or treatment. It can improve treatment selection but does not guarantee a response.

Personal Protective Equipment

Clothing or equipment that protects a person from infection, chemicals, blood, or other hazards. It may include gloves, gowns, masks, respirators, goggles, or face shields; selection and safe use depend on the hazard.

Person With Disability

A person with disability has a long-term physical, sensory, intellectual, or mental-health impairment that may interact with barriers to limit participation; accessible, person-centered care accounts for these barriers.

Perspiration

Sweat released by skin glands. Eccrine glands mainly help cool the body, while apocrine glands contribute to odor after their secretions are changed by skin bacteria; unusually heavy sweating is called hyperhidrosis.

Pertussis

Alternate name; see *Whooping Cough*.

Pertussis Toxin

A toxin produced by Bordetella pertussis that disrupts cell signaling and contributes to the cough and systemic effects of whooping cough.

Pertuzumab

A monoclonal antibody targeting the HER2 receptor and blocking its dimerization, used with other medicines for selected HER2-positive cancers.

Pervasive Developmental Disorders

An older name for a group of diagnoses affecting development and social communication. The group included autism, Asperger syndrome, and PDD-NOS, a diagnosis for people who did not fit other categories. DSM-5 replaced most of these diagnoses with autism spectrum disorder (ASD).

Alternate Names:
Pervasive Developmental Disorder; PDD

Pes

Pes means foot; it is also used in terms describing foot shape or deformity, such as pes planus or pes

cavus.

Pes Anserinus

The combined tendon insertion of the sartorius, gracilis, and semitendinosus muscles on the anteromedial proximal tibia; inflammation there is pes anserine bursitis.

Pes Cavus

A high-arched foot deformity characterized by an abnormally elevated medial longitudinal arch that does not flatten with weight-bearing, frequently associated with neuromuscular disorders including Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease, Friedreich ataxia, and spinal dysraphism.

Alternate Names:
High-Arched Foot; Talipes Cavus

Pes Planus

Alternate name; see *Flatfoot (Pes Planus)*.

Pessaries

Devices placed inside the vagina to support organs that have descended, such as the bladder, uterus, or rectum. Ring, cube, and other designs suit different shapes; prolonged use can cause sores, discharge, or infection.

Pessary

A device placed inside the vagina to support pelvic organs, treat prolapse, or sometimes prevent leakage of urine.

Pessimism

A tendency to expect negative outcomes or interpret situations unfavorably.

Pesticide

Any chemical substance or biological agent formulated to repel, prevent, destroy, or mitigate pests, including insecticides, herbicides, rodenticides, and fungicides. Human exposure can cause acute toxicity (e.g., organophosphate-induced cholinergic crisis via acetylcholinesterase inhibition, leading to SLUDGE syndrome and respiratory arrest) or chronic neurotoxic, carcinogenic, dermatologic, and reproductive sequelae.

Alternate Names:
Pesticides

Pesticide Poisoning

Toxic exposure to an insecticide, herbicide, fungicide, rodenticide, or related agricultural chemical. Clinical findings and treatment depend on the active ingredient: cholinergic toxidromes, corrosive injury, methemoglobinemia, hepatic or renal injury, seizures, shock, and coagulopathy are possible. Identify the product, decontaminate safely, and use agent-specific toxicology guidance.

Pesticides

Plural form; see *Pesticide*.

Pesticides On Fruits And Vegetables

Small pesticide residues on properly washed produce usually do not cause acute poisoning. Concentrated pesticide exposure can cause vomiting, sweating, breathing difficulty, weakness, or confusion.

Pestilence

Pestilence is an old term for a severe, widespread, often fatal infectious disease outbreak; modern usage usually specifies the pathogen and epidemiologic event.

Pet Allergy

An allergic reaction to proteins in an animal's skin flakes, saliva, or urine, commonly causing rhinitis, conjunctivitis, or asthma.

Alternate Names:
Animal Dander Allergy; Pet Dander Hypersensitivity

PET/CT

A scan that combines PET, which shows active body processes, with CT, which shows detailed anatomy. It helps locate disease and assess selected cancers, heart conditions, and brain disorders; it uses a radioactive tracer and X-rays.

Petechia

Alternate name; see *Petechiae*.

Petechiae

Pinpoint, flat, non-blanching red, purple, or brown macules measuring less than two to three millimetres in diameter, caused by minor capillary hemorrhage and extravasation of erythrocytes into the skin or mucous membranes. Major causes include thrombocytopenia (such as immune thrombocytopenia, leukemia, or aplastic anemia), platelet dysfunction, life-threatening infections (meningococcemia, infective endocarditis, viral hemorrhagic fevers), vasculitis, and acute mechanical elevation of venous pressure from violent coughing or vomiting.

Alternate Names:
Petechia; Pinpoint Hemorrhages

Petit Mal

Older term; see *Absence Seizure*.

Petit Mal Seizure

Alternate name; see *Absence Seizure*.

PET/MRI

A scan that combines information about tissue activity with detailed MRI images of soft tissues. It is useful for selected brain, cancer, and heart problems and does not use X-rays, but takes longer than many other imaging tests.

Petrissage

A massage technique involving kneading, squeezing, or lifting soft tissues. It can aggravate acute injury, infection, clot risk, or fragile skin.

Petrolatum

A semisolid purified mixture of hydrocarbons used on skin as a protective ointment and moisture barrier. It reduces water loss, shields minor irritation, and supports healing of dry, cracked, or chafed skin.

Petroleum Jelly Overdose

Swallowing a small amount of petroleum jelly usually causes little harm, but larger amounts can cause diarrhea or vomiting. If it enters the lungs, it may cause inflammation and breathing problems; contact poison control after a significant exposure.

Petrosal Sinus

Paired dural venous sinuses draining the cavernous sinus: the superior petrosal sinus courses along the crest of the petrous temporal bone into the transverse sinus, while the inferior petrosal sinus travels in the petro-occipital fissure through the anterior jugular foramen into the internal jugular vein.

Petrositis

Inflammation or infection of the petrous portion of the temporal bone, usually arising from complicated otitis media and potentially affecting nearby cranial nerves.

Petrous

Describing dense, hard bone, especially the part of the temporal bone that houses inner-ear structures.

PET Scan

Nuclear medicine imaging using radioactive tracers (most commonly FDG, a glucose analog) to detect metabolically active tissues.

Alternate Names:
PET Imaging; PET-CT

PET Scan For Breast Cancer

Positron-emission tomography, usually combined with computed tomography, used selectively to assess metabolically active breast cancer, staging, recurrence, or treatment response.

PET Scanner

A machine that detects radiation from a tracer inside the body and creates images showing how actively tissues use substances such as glucose. It is used to assess selected cancers and other disorders.

PET Tracers

Radioactive substances used during a PET scan to highlight particular body processes. Different tracers show glucose use, bone activity, or specific

cell receptors; the appropriate tracer depends on the clinical question.

Peutz-Jeghers's Syndrome

An inherited condition causing dark patches around the mouth and many growths in the stomach or intestines. The growths may bleed, cause blockage, or increase the risk of digestive and other cancers.

Peutz-Jeghers Syndrome

An inherited condition causing dark spots on the lips, mouth, fingers, or skin and multiple growths in the digestive tract. These growths can bleed or block the bowel and increase the risk of several cancers.

Alternate Names:
PJS

PEWS

Alternate name; see *Pediatric Early Warning Score*.

Pexophagy

A cell-cleaning process that removes damaged or unneeded peroxisomes, the small structures that process certain fats and harmful chemicals. The cell breaks them down and reuses some of their materials.

Peyer Patches

Clusters of immune tissue in the wall of the lower small intestine. They sample material from the gut and help the immune system recognize and respond to germs while tolerating normal food and bacteria.

Peyer's Patches

Organized lymphoid tissue in the mucosa and submucosa of the ileum. These aggregates sample intestinal contents and contribute to immune surveillance of the gastrointestinal tract.

Alternate Names:
Ileal Lymphoid Nodules; Aggregated Lymphoid Nodules

Peyronie Disease

A condition in which scar-like tissue forms in the covering of the erectile chambers. It can cause a bend, dent, shortening, or pain during erection and may make sex difficult. The bend may change at first and later become stable.

Peyronie's Disease

Alternate name; see *Peyronie Disease*.

Alternate Names:
Peyronie's Disease

PFAPA Syndrome

A recurrent fever syndrome, usually beginning in childhood, characterized by periodic fever with some combination of mouth ulcers, sore throat, and swollen neck lymph nodes; it is commonly abbreviated PFAPA.

Pfeiffer Syndrome

An autosomal dominant craniosynostosis syndrome caused by FGFR1 or FGFR2 mutations.

Alternate Names:
Classic Type Pfeiffer Syndrome Features: craniosynostosis (bilateral coronal), midface hypoplasia, proptosis, hypertelorism, broad thumbs and great toes (medial deviation), and variable syndactyly.

Alternate Names:
Acrocephalosyndactyly Type V

Pfeiffer Syndrome Type I

The milder form of Pfeiffer syndrome, a genetic craniosynostosis disorder usually associated with broad or deviated thumbs and great toes and premature fusion of some skull sutures. Severity and developmental effects vary.

P-Glycoprotein

A transport protein in cell membranes that pumps many medicines and other substances out of cells. It affects how medicines are absorbed and removed and can cause interactions when its activity is blocked or increased.

pH

A measure of how acidic or alkaline a solution is, usually on a scale from 0 to 14. Body fluids have

tightly controlled pH ranges, and major changes can be dangerous.

Phacoemulsification

A cataract extraction technique in which an ultrasonic probe fragments and aspirates the opacified crystalline lens through a small incision. An intraocular lens is usually implanted afterward.

Alternate Names:
Phaco; Phaco Surgery; Ultrasonic Cataract Extraction

Phacomatosis

A broad group of congenital hereditary neurocutaneous syndromes characterized by widespread hamartomatous developmental lesions simultaneously involving structures of ectodermal origin (central nervous system, retina, and skin), including neurofibromatosis, tuberous sclerosis, and von Hippel-Lindau disease.

Alternate Names:
Neurocutaneous Syndrome

Phaeohyphomycosis

An infection caused by melanized (dematiaceous) fungi, which appear in tissue as pigmented hyphae, yeast-like cells, or both. Disease may be cutaneous or subcutaneous, or involve deeper sites such as the lungs, brain, bones, or multiple organs.

Phagocyte

A specialized immune cell capable of ingesting, engulfing, and digesting cellular debris, foreign particles, pathogens, and apoptotic cells via phagocytosis. Key phagocytic cells include neutrophils, monocytes, tissue macrophages, and dendritic cells, which utilize pattern recognition receptors (PRRs) to identify pathogen-associated molecular patterns (PAMPs), trigger oxidative bursts, and facilitate antigen presentation to adaptive immune cells.

Alternate Names:
Phagocytes; Phagocytic Cell

Phagocytes

Plural form; see *Phagocyte*.

Phagocytic Vesicle

A small membrane-bound compartment formed inside a cell after it surrounds and swallows a germ, dead cell, or particle. It later joins a digestive compartment so the material can be broken down.

Phagocytosis

The process by which a cell surrounds, takes in, and breaks down a particle or microorganism. Immune cells use it to remove germs, dead cells, and harmful debris from tissues.

Phagolysosome

A compartment formed when an immune cell's swallowed-particle compartment joins a digestive compartment. Enzymes and other chemicals inside it destroy germs and break down cellular debris.

Phagophore

A temporary membrane that grows around damaged or unnecessary material inside a cell during recycling. It closes around the material so the cell can break it down and reuse some of its parts.

Phakomatosis TS

Alternate name; see *Tuberous Sclerosis Complex*.

Phalangeal Fractures

Breaks in the bones of the fingers or toes, usually caused by crushing, direct impact, or twisting. Pain, swelling, bruising, deformity, and difficulty moving the digit may occur; alignment and nail-bed injury should be assessed.

Phalanges

The bones of the fingers and toes. The thumb and big toe each have two, while the other digits usually have three. Fractures, arthritis, infection, or nerve problems in these bones can cause pain, swelling, stiffness, or difficulty using the hand or foot.

Phalanx

One of the bones of a finger or toe. Each phalanx has a base, shaft, and end; the end bone supports the fingertip or toenail. The thumb and big toe

have two phalanges, while other digits usually have three.

Phalanx Unspecified

A phalanx is one of the bones of a finger or toe; "unspecified" indicates that the particular digit or proximal, middle, or distal segment is not identified.

Phalen Maneuver

A diagnostic physical examination provocative test for carpal tunnel syndrome; the patient rests both elbows on a flat surface and maintains full passive wrist flexion (at 90 degrees) by pressing the dorsal surfaces of the hands together for 60 seconds; reproduction of paresthesias or pain in the median nerve distribution indicates a positive test.

Alternate Names:
Phalen's Test; Wrist Flexion Test

Phalen Sign

Tingling or numbness in the fingers after pressing the backs of the hands together with wrists bent down for one minute, used to check for carpal tunnel syndrome.

Phalen Test

A test in which the wrists are bent to see whether numbness or tingling develops. Reproduced symptoms may support carpal tunnel syndrome, but the result must be interpreted with examination and other tests.

Phantom

A test object made to resemble human tissue or organs so medical imaging equipment can be checked and calibrated. Different phantoms test image quality, measurements, or specific body regions.

Phantom Limb

The feeling that an amputated body part is still present. Sensations may include position, movement, itching, pressure, or pain and often change over time after amputation.

Alternate Names:
Phantom Limb Sensation; Phantom Limb Pain

Phantom Limb Pain

Painful sensations perceived in a limb that has been amputated, caused by persistent or reorganized activity in peripheral nerves and central sensory pathways. It may feel burning, shooting, cramping, or electric.

Phantom Pain

Pain perceived in a body part that has been amputated, caused by changes in peripheral nerves and central pain-processing pathways.

Phantom Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Pseudocyesis*.

Phantosmia

Perception of a smell when no corresponding odor is present. It may occur with sinonasal disease, migraine, seizures involving olfactory networks, head injury, neurodegenerative disease, infection, or other neurological conditions.

Pharmaceutical Adjuvant

A pharmaceutical adjuvant is an inactive or auxiliary ingredient added to improve a medicine's stability, absorption, preservation, delivery, or therapeutic effect.

Pharmaceutical Excipient

A pharmaceutical excipient is a non-active ingredient in a dosage form, such as a filler, binder, coating, solvent, preservative, or disintegrant.

Pharmaceutical Solutions

Liquid preparations in which one or more active pharmaceutical ingredients are dissolved in a suitable vehicle for administration, with concentration, sterility, stability, and route determining safe use.

Pharmacist

A medicine expert who prepares and dispenses drugs, checks safety, and explains correct use and possible side effects.

Pharmacodynamic Drug Interaction

An interaction in which two medicines have additive, opposing, or otherwise changed effects on the same body system, even when their blood concentrations are not altered.

Pharmacodynamics

The study of the biochemical and physiological effects of drugs on the body and their mechanisms of action, describing what the drug does to the body.

Pharmacoepidemiology

The study of how medicines are used and affect health in large populations. It helps assess effectiveness, safety, adverse effects, and patterns of prescribing.

Pharmacogenetics

Pharmacogenetics studies how inherited genetic variation alters a person's response to medicines, including efficacy, metabolism, and adverse-effect risk, to support individualized prescribing.

Pharmacogenetic Testing

Testing for genetic variants that influence a person's response, metabolism, efficacy, or toxicity of particular medicines and may support individualized prescribing.

Pharmacogenic Myopathy

Muscle weakness or muscle injury caused by a medicine or drug. The presentation can include pain, cramps, elevated creatine kinase, or rhabdomyolysis, and evaluation considers the timing, dose, interactions, and other causes.

Pharmacogenomics

The study of how genetic variations influence individual responses to drugs, including drug efficacy, toxicity, and metabolism. Genetic polymorphisms in drug-metabolizing enzymes, transporters, and receptors can lead to significant inter-individual variability in drug response.

Pharmacogenomic Testing

Testing that examines genetic variants affecting drug metabolism, transport, targets, or adverse reactions to help select or dose certain medicines.

Pharmacokinetic Drug Interaction

An interaction in which one medicine changes another medicine's absorption, distribution, metabolism, or elimination, altering its concentration or duration of action.

Pharmacokinetics

The study of what the body does to a medicine, including its absorption, distribution, metabolism, and elimination. It helps explain drug concentrations over time and supports dose selection.

Pharmacological Stress Test

A heart stress test using medicine to imitate exercise when a person cannot exercise adequately. Imaging or heart recordings show blood flow and function, while possible effects include chest discomfort, breathlessness, or abnormal rhythm.

Pharmacologic Substance

A pharmacologic substance is a chemical that produces a biological effect by interacting with cells, receptors, enzymes, transporters, or other targets.

Pharmacologist

A pharmacologist studies how medicines and chemicals act in living systems, including mechanisms, metabolism, toxicity, and therapeutic effects.

Pharmacology

The study of medicines and other drugs, including how they act and affect the body. It covers drug mechanisms, absorption, distribution, metabolism, elimination, uses, adverse effects, and interactions. Clinical pharmacology studies these effects in people.

Pharmacopoeia

A pharmacopoeia is an official reference specifying standards for identity, purity, strength, testing, and

preparation of medicines.

Pharmacoproteomics

The study of how a person's protein patterns influence medicine response, drug effects, or toxicity. It is an emerging part of precision medicine.

Pharmacotherapy

Pharmacotherapy is treatment with medicines chosen to prevent, relieve, or control a disease or symptom.

Pharmacovigilance

The science and activities relating to the detection, assessment, understanding, and prevention of adverse drug reactions and other drug-related problems.

Pharmacy

The healthcare field concerned with preparing, checking, supplying, and explaining medicines. Pharmacists help choose safe doses, identify interactions and allergies, support treatment decisions, and teach people how to use medicines correctly.

Pharmacy Facility

A pharmacy facility is an authorized location where medicines may be stored, prepared, dispensed, monitored, and supplied under applicable professional and safety standards.

Pharyngeal

Relating to the pharynx, or throat. The pharynx connects the nose and mouth with the voice box, food pipe, and breathing passages. Infection, swelling, narrowing, or a tumor there may cause sore throat, swallowing difficulty, noisy breathing, or voice changes.

Pharyngeal Cancer

Alternate name; see *Throat Cancer*.

Pharyngeal Carcinoma

Pharyngeal carcinoma is cancer arising in the throat and may cause persistent sore throat, swallowing difficulty, hoarseness, or a neck mass.

Pharyngeal Disease

A disorder affecting the throat, including infection, inflammation, blockage, injury, muscle or nerve problems, or a tumor. Symptoms may include sore throat, swallowing difficulty, choking, voice changes, or breathing problems.

Pharyngeal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the pharynx caused by trauma, surgery, infection, vascular lesions, tumor, or severe mucosal disease and potentially threatening the airway.

Pharyngeal Mucositis

Inflammation and ulceration of the throat lining, commonly caused by radiation, chemotherapy, infection, trauma, or medications and producing pain, difficulty swallowing, and reduced intake.

Pharyngeal Stenosis

Narrowing of the pharyngeal passage caused by scarring, congenital abnormality, tumor, inflammation, or surgery, which may impair swallowing or breathing.

Pharyngeal Tonsil

Adenoid tissue in the roof of the throat behind the nose that helps immune defense, especially in children.

Pharyngectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the throat, usually to treat cancer. Depending on the extent, reconstruction or a temporary feeding tube may be needed, and treatment can affect swallowing, speech, breathing, or appearance.

Pharyngitis

Inflammation of the throat that causes a sore throat and sometimes fever or swollen neck glands. Most cases are caused by viruses; group A streptococcus is an important bacterial cause.

Alternate Names:

Sore Throat; Acute Pharyngitis; Pharyngeal Inflammation

Pharyngolaryngeal Pain

Pain involving the pharynx and larynx, commonly associated with infection, inflammation, irritation, trauma, reflux, or malignancy.

Pharyngomaxillary Space Abscess

A pharyngomaxillary space abscess is a deep infection containing pus near the pharynx and maxilla that can cause severe pain, swelling, difficulty swallowing, and airway risk.

Pharynx

The muscular passage behind the nose and mouth that carries air toward the voice box and food toward the esophagus. It helps with breathing, swallowing, and speech.

Pharynx Necrosis

Death of tissue in the throat caused by severe infection, ischemia, radiation, caustic injury, or tumor, with risk of deep infection, bleeding, airway compromise, and sepsis.

Pharynx Neoplasm

A pharynx neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the throat that may be benign or malignant.

Phase-Contrast Microscopy

A microscope technique that makes transparent cells and other specimens easier to see by converting small differences in light passing through them into visible contrast. It is useful for examining living, unstained cells.

Phase II Metabolism

A stage of drug breakdown in which the body attaches another chemical group to a medicine or its earlier breakdown product. This usually makes the substance easier to remove in urine or bile.

Phase I Metabolism

An early step in the body's breakdown of many medicines. Enzymes, mainly in the liver, chemically change a medicine by adding or exposing a reactive part; this may inactivate it, activate it, or prepare it for further breakdown.

Phe

Phe is the standard abbreviation for phenylalanine, an essential amino acid incorporated into proteins and metabolized through a pathway disrupted in phenylketonuria.

Phelan-McDermid Syndrome

A genetic disorder that commonly causes low muscle tone, delayed development, intellectual disability, very limited speech, and autism-related behaviors. Some people have reduced sensitivity to pain, seizures, feeding problems, or kidney and heart abnormalities. It usually results from loss of genetic material near the end of chromosome 22 or a change in the *SHANK3* gene.

Alternate Names:
22q13.3 Deletion Syndrome

Phenacetin

Phenacetin is a former analgesic and fever-reducing drug withdrawn or restricted because long-term use can cause kidney damage and increase cancer risk.

Phenazopyridine

Phenazopyridine is a urinary analgesic that temporarily relieves dysuria without treating its cause; it can turn urine orange and prolonged or excessive use may cause haemolysis or methemoglobinaemia.

Phencyclidine

A dissociative drug that can cause altered perception, agitation, hallucinations, impaired coordination, or dangerous behavior.

Phencyclidine Overdose

An excessive amount of the dissociative drug phencyclidine can cause agitation, hallucinations, high body temperature, high blood pressure, seizures, loss of coordination, coma, or injury.

Phencyclidine Substance Use

Phencyclidine is a dissociative drug that can cause agitation, hallucinations, loss of coordination, high blood pressure, seizures, dangerous behavior, or coma.

Phenelzine

An antidepressant that blocks monoamine oxidase, an enzyme breaking down several brain chemicals. It has important interactions with medicines and tyramine-rich foods and can cause dangerous high blood pressure if precautions are ignored.

Phenethylamines

Phenethylamines are a chemical family including neurotransmitters, medicines, and psychoactive substances that can affect adrenergic, dopaminergic, or serotonergic signaling.

Phenformin

Phenformin is a former biguanide diabetes medicine withdrawn because it can cause life-threatening lactic acidosis.

Phenindione

An older oral anticoagulant that interferes with vitamin-K-dependent clotting factors.

Pheniramine Overdose

An excessive amount of pheniramine, an antihistamine, can cause extreme sleepiness or agitation, dry mouth, large pupils, fast heartbeat, seizures, abnormal rhythms, or coma.

Phenobarbital

Phenobarbital is a long-acting barbiturate anti-seizure medicine that enhances GABA-A receptor inhibition; sedation, respiratory depression, cognitive effects, dependence, and enzyme-inducing drug interactions are important risks.

Phenobarbital Overdose

Taking too much phenobarbital can cause severe drowsiness, poor coordination, low blood pressure, slowed breathing, coma, or death. Emergency treatment is required, especially if alcohol or another sedative was also taken.

Phenobarbitone

The British name for phenobarbital, a barbiturate anticonvulsant and sedative.

Phenol

An aromatic organic compound consisting of a hydroxyl group attached directly to a benzene ring (carbolic acid), as well as the class of chemical derivatives containing this basic core. Used historically as a surgical antiseptic and currently as a neurolytic agent, chemical peeling agent, and industrial precursor, concentrated phenol causes rapid chemical burns, tissue necrosis, and systemic toxicity including central nervous system depression, cardiac arrhythmias, and renal tubular injury.

Alternate Names:
Phenols; Carbolic Acid

Phenols

Plural form; see *Phenol*.

Phenomenon

An observable event, sign, or pattern in the body. Examples include fingers changing color in Raynaud phenomenon, early-morning blood-sugar rises in the dawn phenomenon, and upward eye movement when the eyelids close in Bell phenomenon.

Phenothiazine

A tricyclic chemical compound and prototype class of first-generation (typical) neuroleptic antipsychotics that act primarily by antagonizing central dopamine D_2 receptors in the mesolimbic and nigrostriatal pathways. Agents such as chlorpromazine, fluphenazine, and prochlorperazine are utilized for psychotic disorders and severe nausea, with adverse effect profiles featuring extrapyramidal symptoms (acute dystonia, parkinsonism, akathisia, tardive dyskinesia), sedation, anticholinergic effects, orthostatic hypotension, and neuroleptic malignant syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Phenothiazines; Phenothiazine Antipsychotic

Phenothiazine Overdose

An excessive amount of a phenothiazine medicine can cause sleepiness, confusion, low blood pressure, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, or severe muscle stiffness and fever.

Phenothiazines

Plural form; see *Phenothiazine*.

Phenotype

The observable features of a person, such as appearance, growth, body functions, and behavior. These features result from the interaction between inherited genetic information and the environment.

Phenoxybenzamine

A long-acting alpha-blocker used mainly before surgery for a catecholamine-secreting tumor such as pheochromocytoma. It can cause dizziness, low blood pressure, rapid heartbeat, and nasal congestion.

Phenoxymethylpenicillin

Penicillin V, an oral penicillin used for selected susceptible infections.

Phenprocoumon

Phenprocoumon is a long-acting vitamin-K antagonist anticoagulant that reduces clotting-factor production and requires coagulation monitoring.

Phentermine

A stimulant medicine that reduces appetite and may be used short term with diet and activity changes for weight management. It can raise heart rate and blood pressure and may cause insomnia, anxiety, dependence, or dangerous interactions with some medicines.

Phenthoate

Phenthoate is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic poisoning after exposure.

Phentolamine

Phentolamine is a short-acting alpha-adrenergic blocker used for catecholamine-related hypertension and to limit tissue injury after certain vasoconstrictor leaks.

Phenylacetate

A salt or ester of phenylacetic acid used in some metabolic and experimental medical applications; it can bind nitrogen-containing metabolites.

Phenylalanine

An essential amino acid incorporated into proteins and converted to tyrosine; impaired metabolism causes phenylketonuria and requires dietary or medical management.

Phenylbutazone

An older anti-inflammatory pain medicine whose use is limited by serious toxicity. It can cause stomach bleeding, kidney or liver injury, fluid retention, blood-cell problems, allergic reactions, and other dangerous effects.

Phenylbutyrate

A nitrogen-scavenging medicine converted to phenylacetate, which combines with glutamine and facilitates nitrogen excretion in selected urea-cycle disorders.

Phenylephrine

A medicine that narrows blood vessels. It may reduce a blocked nose, raise dangerously low blood pressure in hospital care, or widen the pupil in an eye examination; it can worsen high blood pressure, heart problems, or urinary difficulty in some people.

Phenylketonuria

Phenylketonuria is an inherited disorder, usually caused by pathogenic variants in both copies of the PAH gene. Reduced activity of the enzyme phenylalanine hydroxylase impairs the conversion of phenylalanine to tyrosine, causing phenylalanine to build up in the blood. If untreated, high phenylalanine levels can harm brain development and cause intellectual disability, seizures, and behavioral

problems. Newborn screening usually detects the disorder before symptoms begin.

Alternate Names:
PKU; Phenylalanine Hydroxylase Deficiency

Phenylketonuria (PKU)

Alternate name; see *Phenylketonuria*.

Phenylpropanolamine

A sympathomimetic decongestant formerly used in some products; it can raise blood pressure and has been restricted because of safety concerns.

Phenytoin

A medicine used to prevent or control some seizures. It reduces repeated electrical activity in brain cells; levels in the blood may need monitoring because interactions and side effects can include dizziness, poor coordination, gum overgrowth, skin reactions, or serious toxicity.

Phenytoin Overdose

Too much phenytoin can cause nausea, severe dizziness, double vision, involuntary eye movements, poor coordination, confusion, abnormal heart rhythms, or coma. Significant or intentional overdoses can be life-threatening.

Phenytoin Sodium

The sodium salt of phenytoin, an anticonvulsant used for selected focal and generalized tonic-clonic seizures; toxicity can cause nystagmus, ataxia, arrhythmia, or severe skin reactions.

Phenytoin Toxicity

Dose-related toxicity causing horizontal nystagmus, ataxia, dysarthria, lethargy, confusion, or coma; severe overdose can cause hypotension, dysrhythmias, or seizures, particularly after rapid intravenous administration. Serial serum levels, ECG, and neurologic assessment guide supportive care; there is no routine specific antidote.

Pheochromocytoma

A rare neuroendocrine tumor that develops in the adrenal glands, the small glands located on top of each kidney. The tumor causes the adrenal gland to overproduce catecholamines—hormones such as adrenaline and noradrenaline that control the body's fight-or-flight response. This surge of hormones causes episodic or persistent high blood pressure, pounding headaches, heavy sweating, a rapid or pounding heartbeat, and feelings of extreme anxiety.

Alternate Names:
Chromaffin Cell Tumor; Adrenal Medullary Tumor; Pheo

Pheresis

A procedure that removes a selected part of blood, such as plasma, platelets, or white blood cells, and returns the remaining blood. It may treat disease or collect a needed blood component from a donor.

Pheromone

A pheromone is a chemical signal released by an organism that alters behavior or physiology in another member of the same species.

Phialophora

A genus of darkly pigmented fungi that can cause chromoblastomycosis or other subcutaneous and opportunistic infections.

Phialophora Verrucosa

A dark-pigmented fungus that commonly causes chromoblastomycosis, a long-lasting infection of skin and tissue beneath it. Infection usually follows implantation through injured skin and produces slowly enlarging warty or raised lesions.

Philadelphia Chromosome

A rearrangement of genetic material between chromosomes 9 and 22 that creates the BCR::ABL1 gene. It is found in most cases of chronic myeloid leukemia and some acute leukemias and helps guide treatment.

Philodendron Poisoning

Chewing philodendron leaves releases irritating crystals that can cause immediate burning and swelling of the mouth, tongue, or throat. Breathing or swal-

lowing difficulty may occur.

Phimosis

A foreskin that is too tight to pull back over the head of the penis. This is a normal stage of development in babies and many young children as the foreskin separates with age. Scarring or inflammation can cause lasting tightness, which may lead to pain, repeated inflammation, or difficulty urinating.

Phimosis and Paraphimosis

See *Phimosis* and *Paraphimosis*.

Phlebitis

Inflammation of a vein causing pain, warmth, redness, or tenderness along its course. It may follow irritation from an intravenous line or occur with a clot in a surface vein; sudden limb swelling or breathlessness may indicate a more serious clot.

Phlegmonous Gastritis

A rare, severe bacterial infection of the stomach wall, especially its deeper layers. It can cause sudden abdominal pain, fever, nausea, and vomiting and may lead to tissue damage or sepsis.

Phlebitis And Thrombophlebitis

Phlebitis is inflammation of a vein, while thrombophlebitis includes a clot within the inflamed vein. Superficial disease causes localized pain and redness; deep-vein thrombosis can embolize to the lungs and is suspected with limb swelling, pain, or breathlessness.

Phlebography

An imaging test in which contrast dye is injected into a vein to show the veins on X-ray. It can detect a blood clot or an abnormal vein but is now often replaced by ultrasound.

Phlebotomy

Taking blood from a vein, usually with a needle, for testing, donation, or treatment. The procedure may cause brief pain, bruising, bleeding, fainting, or rarely infection; trained staff use safe collection and labeling practices.

Alternate Names:
Venipuncture

Phlebovirus

A genus of segmented RNA viruses, many transmitted by sandflies or mosquitoes; some cause fever, encephalitis, or hemorrhagic disease.

Phlegm

Thick mucus brought up by coughing from the lower airways. Its amount and appearance can change with infection, asthma, smoking, chronic lung disease, or other conditions.

Phlegmasia Alba Dolens

Painful, marked swelling and pallor of a limb caused by extensive deep-vein thrombosis, usually involving major venous outflow. It can threaten the limb and circulation.

Alternate Names:
Milk Leg; Femoral Thrombophlebitis

Phlegmasia Cerulea Dolens

Phlegmasia cerulea dolens is a severe, extensive deep-vein thrombosis that obstructs venous outflow, causing painful swollen blue discoloration and risking limb ischemia or pulmonary embolism.

PH Meter

An instrument that measures acidity or alkalinity as pH in a solution or specimen; clinical applications include gastric, urinary, laboratory, and environmental measurements.

PH Monitoring

Measurement of acidity, usually in the esophagus, over time with a small sensor. It can help detect and measure acid reflux when symptoms or endoscopy do not give a clear answer.

Phobia

An intense, persistent, and irrational fear of a specific object, creature, activity, or situation that is disproportional to the actual threat posed, prompt-

ing immediate distress and active avoidance that impairs normal daily functioning. Categories include specific phobias (e.g., animal, natural environment, blood-injection-injury, situational), social anxiety disorder (social phobia), and agoraphobia. First-line management involves graded exposure therapy and cognitive-behavioral techniques.

Alternate Names:
Phobias; Phobic Disorder

Phobias

Plural form; see *Phobia*.

Phobic Disorder

A disorder characterized by clinically significant fear and avoidance of a particular object or situation.

Phocomelia

A rare congenital limb-development defect in which hands or feet are attached close to the trunk because of absent or severely shortened long bones.

Phonation

Production of voiced sound when exhaled air makes the vocal folds vibrate in the larynx; disorders cause hoarseness, weak voice, or loss of voice.

Phonocardiogram

A graphic recording of heart sounds and murmurs, traditionally made with a microphone over the chest. It can document timing and duration but is usually interpreted with examination and echocardiography.

Phonocardiography

Recording heart sounds and murmurs with a microphone, producing a tracing that can help evaluate heart valve problems.

Phonological Disorder

A communication disorder involving persistent difficulty producing or organizing speech sounds beyond what is expected for age and language development.

Phonophobia

Unusual sensitivity to sound or distress caused by ordinary sounds. It often occurs with migraine but may also accompany concussion, infection, anxiety, or other conditions; new severe sound sensitivity with headache or neurological symptoms can indicate serious disease.

Phorate

Phorate is a highly toxic organophosphate pesticide whose exposure can produce excessive cholinergic activity and medical emergency.

Phorbols

Phorbols are diterpene compounds related to phorbol esters that can activate cellular protein kinase C signaling.

Phorometer

An instrument used to measure ocular alignment and the amount of prism correction needed for binocular vision disorders.

Phosgene

A highly toxic industrial gas that reacts with moist respiratory tissues and can cause delayed pulmonary edema, cough, chest tightness, and respiratory failure after exposure.

Phosgene Oxime

A highly corrosive chemical warfare agent that causes immediate severe pain, skin and eye injury, airway damage, and tissue necrosis on contact.

Phosmet

Phosmet is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after substantial exposure.

Phosphamidon

A poisonous organophosphate insecticide. Exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, muscle twitching, breathing difficulty, seizures, or weakness because it disrupts nerve signals.

Phosphate

An inorganic ion and component of nucleotides, phospholipids, proteins, and bone mineral. It participates in ATP energy transfer, phosphorylation-dependent signaling, intracellular buffering, and acid excretion by the kidney.

Phosphate Test

A blood test measuring inorganic phosphorus/phosphate, vital for bone mineralization, energy metabolism, and cellular signaling; see *Phosphate*.

Phosphate Binders

Medicines taken with meals that bind phosphate in food inside the intestine, reducing its absorption. They are used mainly in advanced kidney disease when blood phosphate is high. The choice depends on calcium levels, vascular calcification, other illnesses, and treatment response.

Phosphate Homeostasis

The body keeps blood phosphate within a useful range through the coordinated actions of the parathyroid glands, vitamin D, kidneys, intestines, and bones. Kidney disease can disrupt this balance.

Phosphatidic Acid

A membrane phospholipid and signaling intermediate that serves as a precursor for other glycerolipids and influences membrane curvature, trafficking, and cell growth.

Phosphatidylcholine

A major membrane phospholipid and component of pulmonary surfactant, lipoproteins, and bile; it also participates in cell signaling.

Phosphatidylethanolamines

Membrane phospholipids containing ethanolamine that help determine membrane structure, fusion, and cell signaling. A group of cell-membrane fats that help maintain membrane shape, join membranes, and support cell signaling.

Phosphatidylinositol

A membrane phospholipid that serves as a precursor for signaling molecules and helps anchor proteins to cell membranes.

Phosphatidylserine

An essential glycerophospholipid component of cell membranes that is normally restricted to the inner (cytoplasmic) leaflet of the lipid bilayer by flippases. During early apoptosis or platelet activation, phosphatidylserine is externalized to the outer leaflet via scramblase activity, serving as an "eat-me" signal recognized by phagocytes and providing a catalytic platform for coagulation factor complexes (tenase and prothrombinase).

Alternate Names:
Phosphatidylserines; PtdSer; PS

Phosphatidylserines

Plural form; see *Phosphatidylserine*.

Phosphaturia

Excretion of phosphate in urine. The amount is regulated by the kidneys and hormones such as parathyroid hormone and is measured when evaluating phosphate balance, kidney-tubule function, or some stone disorders. Excessive renal phosphate loss may occur with proximal tubular dysfunction or hormonal disease.

Phosphaturic Mesenchymal Tumor

A rare tumor that releases a substance causing the kidneys to lose too much phosphate. Low phosphate can soften bones and cause bone pain, weakness, or fractures; removing the tumor often corrects the problem.

Phosphine

A highly toxic gas used in some industrial or pest-control settings that can cause severe lung, heart, liver, kidney, and neurologic injury.

Phosphodiesterase-5 Inhibitors

Medicines that block an enzyme called PDE-5, increasing a chemical signal that relaxes blood vessels.

They are used for erectile dysfunction and some forms of high blood pressure in the lung; concurrent nitrate use can cause severe low blood pressure.

Phosphofructokinase-1

A key enzyme that controls how cells break down sugar to produce energy, especially when energy demand increases.

Phospholipase C Pathway

A system cells use to turn some hormone or nerve signals at their surface into internal actions. It can change calcium levels and control contraction, secretion, growth, or other cell responses.

Phospholipid

A type of lipid with a water-attracting phosphate-containing head and water-repelling fatty-acid tails. Phospholipids form the basic double-layered structure of cell membranes and also help with cell signaling and transport.

Phosphorus

An essential element in bone, nucleic acids, phospholipids, and ATP.

Phosphorus Blood Test

A blood test measuring inorganic phosphate, interpreted with calcium, parathyroid hormone, vitamin D, and kidney function to evaluate mineral and renal disorders.

Phosphorus In Diet

Dietary phosphorus comes from protein-rich foods and many processed foods; people with kidney disease may need individualized limits.

Phosphorylation

Addition of a phosphate group to a molecule, often regulating protein activity or energy transfer.

Photoallergy

An immune-mediated skin reaction that occurs when ultraviolet light activates a sensitizing substance on or in the skin, causing an eczematous rash.

Photocoagulation

Treatment that uses intense light, usually a laser, to heat and seal targeted tissue. In the eye, it can close leaking or abnormal blood vessels and limit damage from conditions such as diabetic retinopathy.

Photodermatosis

A skin disorder caused or aggravated by exposure to ultraviolet or visible light, including polymorphous light eruption, phototoxic reactions, and photoallergic reactions.

Photodynamic Therapy

A treatment that combines a photosensitizing agent with light to generate reactive oxygen species and destroy cancer cells, used for actinic keratosis, superficial skin cancers, and selected visceral tumors.

Photodynamic Therapy For Cancer

Treatment in which a light-sensitive medicine collects in selected abnormal cells and is activated by a specific light, producing substances that destroy nearby cancer cells. It is used for certain accessible cancers and may cause pain, swelling, or temporary light sensitivity.

Photoelectric Effect

An interaction in which tissue absorbs an X-ray and releases an electron. It contributes to how much radiation is absorbed and helps create contrast between tissues on an X-ray image.

Photographic Fixative Poisoning

Harm from swallowing or inhaling chemicals used to process photographs. Effects depend on the product but may include irritation, vomiting, breathing problems, or chemical burns; keep the container and contact poison control.

Photomultiplier Tube

A sensitive device that converts tiny flashes of light into electrical signals. In some medical scanners, groups of these devices help detect and locate radi-

ation emitted by a tracer.

Photopeak

The part of a radiation-measurement graph showing photons that deposited their full energy in the detector. Clinicians use it to select the energy range for interpreting some nuclear medicine scans.

Photopheresis

A treatment in which some blood cells are removed, mixed with a light-sensitive medicine, exposed to ultraviolet light, and returned to the body. It is used for selected immune, blood, and skin disorders under specialist care.

Photophobia

Unusual discomfort or pain caused by light, sometimes leading a person to avoid bright surroundings. It may occur with migraine, corneal injury, eye inflammation, infection, concussion, or meningitis. Severe eye pain, vision loss, fever, stiff neck, or a sudden severe headache can indicate serious disease.

Photoplethysmography

A noninvasive optical method that detects blood-volume changes in tissue. It is used in devices such as pulse oximeters and some heart-rate monitors.

Photoreceptors

Specialized cells in the retina that detect light. Rods support dim-light and peripheral vision, while cones provide color and sharp central vision; damage can reduce sight or cause blind areas.

Photorefractive Keratectomy

Laser surgery that removes a very thin surface layer of the cornea and reshapes the layer beneath it. It can reduce short-sightedness, long-sightedness, or astigmatism, but recovery is slower than some procedures and pain, haze, infection, or imperfect vision can occur.

Photosensitivity

An unusually strong reaction of the skin to sunlight, causing redness, burning, itching, blistering, or a rash on exposed areas. It may result from a disease, inherited tendency, medicine, or chemical.

Photosensitization

Increased sensitivity to ultraviolet or visible light caused by a medication, chemical, or disease, producing an exaggerated skin reaction.

Photosensitizing Drugs

Alternate name; see *Drug-Induced Photosensitivity*.

Phototherapy

Treatment using carefully controlled light for conditions such as newborn jaundice, psoriasis, eczema, or seasonal depression. The wavelength, dose, duration, and eye or skin protection depend on the condition treated.

Phototoxic Dermatitis

A sunburn-like skin injury caused when a medicine or chemical makes the skin react strongly to ultraviolet light. It affects exposed areas and may cause redness, pain, swelling, blisters, or later darkening.

Phototoxicity

Skin injury occurring when a chemical makes skin unusually sensitive to ultraviolet light. It resembles severe sunburn and may cause redness, pain, blistering, or later darkening after medicine or chemical exposure.

Phrenic

Relating to the diaphragm or the phrenic nerves, which arise from the neck and carry the main motor supply to the diaphragm for breathing.

Phrenic Nerve

The nerve arising mainly from C3-C5 that supplies the diaphragm and carries sensory fibers from nearby structures.

Phrenic Nerve Palsy

Paresis or complete paralysis of the phrenic nerve (arising from cervical roots C3, C4, C5), leading to denervation, elevated position, and paradoxical

movement of the ipsilateral hemidiaphragm during inspiration. Common etiologies include mediastinal malignancy (bronchogenic carcinoma), thoracic surgical trauma (cardiac or pulmonary resections), cervical spine trauma, and severe neuralgic amyotrophy.

Alternate Names:
Diaphragmatic Hemiparalysis

PHT

Alternate name; see *Portal Hypertension*.

Phthiriasis

Infestation with lice, especially pubic lice, causing itching and sometimes visible lice or eggs attached to hair. Treatment usually includes an approved lice-killing product, washing or sealing recently used clothing and bedding, and evaluation or treatment of close or sexual contacts.

Phyllodes Tumor

A rare fibroepithelial neoplasm of the breast characterized by leaf-like stromal architecture with hypercellularity and elongated cleft-like epithelial spaces. Classified histologically by the World Health Organization as benign, borderline, or malignant based on stromal cellularity, atypia, mitotic activity, margin status, and stromal overgrowth. Unlike fibroadenomas, they carry a propensity for local recurrence and, in malignant cases, hematogenous metastasis (typically to lungs or bone); treatment requires wide local surgical excision with clear negative margins without routine axillary node dissection.

Alternate Names:
Phyllodes Tumors; Cystosarcoma Phyllodes

Phyllodes Tumors

Plural form; see *Phyllodes Tumor*.

Physiatrist

A doctor who specializes in rehabilitation and in improving movement, function, independence, and quality of life after illness, injury, or disability.

Physical Abuse

Deliberate use of physical force that causes or risks injury, pain, disability, or death. In clinical care, suspected abuse requires attention to immediate safety, documentation, and reporting duties under local law.

Physical Activity

Any movement produced by skeletal muscles that increases energy expenditure, including occupational, household, transportation, and recreational movement. Regular activity supports cardiovascular, metabolic, musculoskeletal, and mental health.

Physical Allergy Urticaria

Hives triggered by a physical stimulus such as pressure, cold, heat, sunlight, vibration, water, or exercise. The trigger causes mast-cell activation and itchy raised welts; severe breathing or circulation symptoms can indicate anaphylaxis.

Physical Child Abuse

Physical child abuse is intentional physical injury or harmful force inflicted on a child, requiring immediate safety assessment, medical care, and safeguarding action.

Physical Dependence

A state in which the body adapts to a substance or medication and develops withdrawal symptoms when it is reduced or stopped.

Physical Exam Frequency

The interval between physical examinations. It varies with age, symptoms, chronic conditions, medicines, pregnancy, and preventive-care guidance rather than following one schedule for everyone.

Physical Examination

A systematic assessment of the body using inspection, palpation, percussion, auscultation, and other examination methods.

Physical Half-Life

The time needed for half the radioactive atoms in a

substance to change through radioactive decay. It describes the substance itself and does not include how quickly the body removes it.

Physical Medicine

Alternate name; see *Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation*.

Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation

The medical specialty focused on improving function and independence after illness or injury. It addresses movement, pain, communication, cognition, and daily activities through rehabilitation medicine and related therapies.

Alternate Names:
PM&R; Physiatry

Physical Therapy

Alternate name; see *Physiotherapy*.

Physical Therapy Assessment

A detailed evaluation of movement, strength, flexibility, sensation, balance, walking, pain, and daily activities. The findings guide treatment goals, exercise choices, equipment needs, safety advice, and progress monitoring.

Physician Assistant

A licensed medical clinician who works with physicians and other healthcare professionals. Depending on local law and practice setting, physician assistants may examine patients, diagnose and treat illness, prescribe medicines, and perform procedures.

Physicians' Desk Reference

A reference source containing prescribing information, indications, contraindications, dosing, warnings, and adverse effects for medicines and selected products.

Physiologic

Physiologic means relating to normal body function or a process occurring within the expected biological range.

Physiological Dead Space

The part of a breath that does not exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide with blood. It includes the air passages and lung areas that receive little or no blood flow.

Physiologic Jaundice Of Newborn

A common temporary yellowing of a newborn's skin and eyes that begins after the first day of life. It results from normal newborn red-cell breakdown and immature liver processing of bilirubin; jaundice that starts earlier or becomes severe can indicate pathologic hyperbilirubinemia.

Physiologic Jaundice Of The Newborn

Physiologic newborn jaundice is a temporary bilirubin rise after birth caused by immature bilirubin processing; jaundice beginning early or becoming severe may have a pathologic cause.

Physiology

The study of how healthy body parts, organs, and living organisms normally work together. It examines processes such as breathing, circulation, digestion, movement, hormone action, nerve signaling, and maintaining internal balance.

Physiotherapy

A healthcare profession that helps people improve movement, strength, function, and independence after injury, illness, surgery, or disability. Treatment may include exercise, movement training, hands-on techniques, and other methods tailored to the person.

Alternate Names:
Physical Therapy; PT; Movement Rehabilitation Therapy

Physostigmine

A reversible acetylcholinesterase inhibitor that may reverse severe central anticholinergic delirium in carefully selected patients after assessment for contraindications and cardiac conduction abnormalities.

Phytomenadione

A form of vitamin K needed by the liver to make several blood-clotting proteins. It is used to prevent or treat bleeding caused by vitamin K deficiency or by medicines that block vitamin K.

Phytophotodermatitis

A phototoxic reaction caused when psoralens or related furocoumarins from plants such as limes, celery, or wild parsnip contact the skin and are followed by ultraviolet-A exposure. Burning, sharply patterned redness, streaks, or blisters may be followed by prolonged postinflammatory hyperpigmentation; it is not an immune-mediated sun allergy.

Phytotherapy

A treatment approach using medicinal plants or plant-derived preparations. Safety and effectiveness vary by product and condition; interactions, contamination, incorrect dosing, and delayed effective care are possible.

PI

Abbreviation for primary immunodeficiency, a group of inherited or acquired disorders in which immune defenses are absent, reduced, or dysfunctional, leading to recurrent or unusual infections and sometimes autoimmune disease.

Pia Mater

The thin, delicate inner covering that closely follows the surface of the brain and spinal cord. Together with the other coverings and fluid around the nervous system, it helps protect these organs.

Pica

Repeated eating of things that have no useful nutritional value, such as soil, paper, ice, or hair, when this is not expected for a person's age or culture. It may cause poisoning, infection, blockage, or poor nutrition and can be linked with iron deficiency or mental-health conditions.

PICC Line Dressing Care

Replacement of the dressing covering a peripherally inserted central catheter site. A sterile technique helps reduce infection risk, and the site is checked for redness, drainage, pain, or catheter movement.

PICC Line Flushing

Passing a prescribed sterile solution through a peripherally inserted central catheter to help keep it open. The solution and method depend on the catheter and local clinical guidance.

PICC Line Insertion

Placement of a thin catheter through a vein in the arm, with its tip advanced to a large vein near the heart. Imaging or other guidance is used to confirm the tip position.

Pick Disease

A distinct subtype of frontotemporal lobar degeneration (FTLD-tau) characterized pathologically by circumscribed knife-edge frontotemporal cortical lobar atrophy and intracellular round, silver-staining, tau-positive inclusions (Pick bodies), presenting with progressive behavioral disinhibition, personality change, and language impairment.

Alternate Names:
Frontotemporal Dementia with Pick Bodies; FTLD-Tau

Pick's Disease

An older term often referring to frontotemporal dementia, a group of disorders causing progressive changes in behavior, personality, language, or executive function. The term is now used less consistently.

Pick's Disease

A historical name for a subtype of frontotemporal dementia characterized by progressive changes in behavior, personality, language, or executive function and, on pathology, characteristic Pick bodies in affected neurons.

Pickwickian Syndrome

An older name for obesity hypoventilation syndrome, involving obesity, daytime hypercapnia, and sleep-disordered breathing.

PID

Alternate name; see *Pelvic Inflammatory Disease*.

Piebaldism

A rare condition present from birth in which some areas of skin and hair lack pigment. It usually causes stable, sharply outlined white patches and often a white section of hair at the front; it is commonly inherited through a change in the KIT gene.

Piedra

A superficial fungal infection of hair shafts producing hard or soft nodules attached to the hair. Black piedra is caused by Piedraia hortae, while white piedra is caused by Trichosporon species; treatment may include hair trimming and antifungal therapy.

Pierre Robin Sequence

A condition present at birth in which a small lower jaw allows the tongue to fall backward and may block breathing. Many affected infants also have a U-shaped opening in the roof of the mouth and feeding difficulty.

Pierson Syndrome

A rare inherited condition causing severe kidney protein loss from birth and unusually small pupils. It can lead to swelling, kidney failure, poor vision, and developmental problems.

Piezogenic Pedal Papules

Small, soft skin-colored papules caused by fat herniating through connective tissue at the edges of the heels when standing. They are common and usually harmless, but may be painful with prolonged standing or in people with connective-tissue disorders.

Pigeon Breast

Alternate name; see *Pectus Carinatum*.

Pigment

A substance that gives skin, hair, eyes, tissue, or other material its color. Pigments may be made by the body, received from outside, or altered by disease, injury, medicines, or aging.

Pigmentary Glaucoma

A secondary open-angle glaucoma caused by dispersion of iris pigment, which accumulates in the trabecular meshwork and impairs aqueous outflow. It may cause raised intraocular pressure and progressive optic-nerve damage.

Pigmentary Mosaicism

Uneven skin coloring caused by groups of skin cells carrying different genetic information. It may produce lighter or darker lines, swirls, or patches; most cases affect only the skin, while some are associated with developmental abnormalities.

Pigmentation

Coloration of skin, hair, eyes, or other tissue produced mainly by melanin, carotenoids, blood, or exogenous material; abnormal changes may reflect inflammation, endocrine disease, drugs, or tumors.

Pigmentation Disorder

A condition causing abnormal increase, decrease, or uneven distribution of pigment in the skin, mucosa, hair, or eye.

Pigment Cirrhosis

Liver cirrhosis associated with abnormal pigment or iron deposition, as may occur in hereditary hemochromatosis.

Pigment Dispersion Syndrome

An ocular condition characterized by the mechanical shedding of pigment granules from the posterior surface of the iris (due to rubbing against lens zonules), which deposit on the corneal endothelium (Krukenberg spindle) and obstruct the trabecular meshwork, predisposing to pigmentary glaucoma.

Pigmented Birthmarks

Areas of darker skin present at birth or appearing in early infancy. Examples include congenital moles, café-au-lait spots, and dermal melanocytosis; some other birthmarks are caused by blood vessels rather than pigment.

Alternate Names:

Birthmarks, Pigmented

Pigmented Purpuric Dermatosis

A group of chronic harmless eruptions caused by leakage of small amounts of blood from superficial vessels. They produce reddish-brown or copper-colored speckles and patches, commonly on the lower legs, and usually do not cause systemic illness.

Pilar Cyst

A usually harmless, firm lump beneath the skin that forms from a hair follicle, most often on the scalp. It may be inherited, become inflamed or painful, and can usually be removed if it causes symptoms or repeated problems.

Piles

Enlarged or swollen blood vessels and supporting tissue in the anus or lower rectum. Internal piles may cause painless bright-red bleeding or tissue protruding during bowel movements; external piles may cause pain, itching, or a tender lump.

Piles (Haemorrhoids)

Alternate name; see *Piles*.

Pill

A solid medicine designed to be taken by mouth. It may contain one or more active ingredients and may release them immediately or slowly; crushing some pills can alter drug release or increase toxicity.

Alternate Names:
Tablet

Pilocarpine

A medicine that activates muscarinic receptors, causing pupil constriction and increased secretions. It may lower eye pressure in glaucoma or relieve dry mouth, but can cause sweating, blurred vision, headache, or breathing problems.

Pilocytic Astrocytoma

A usually slow-growing brain tumor arising from support cells, most often in children. It commonly affects the cerebellum or visual pathway and may cause headache, vomiting, seizures, balance problems, or vision changes.

Piloerection

Elevation of hair shafts producing gooseflesh, caused by contraction of arrector pili muscles under sympathetic stimulation from cold, fear, pain, fever, or certain drugs.

Pilomatrix Carcinoma

A rare skin cancer that develops from cells involved in hair formation. It usually appears as a firm lump on the head, neck, or arm and can grow into nearby tissue or spread elsewhere.

Pilomatrixoma

Pilomatrixoma is a usually benign skin tumor derived from hair-matrix cells, presenting as a firm subcutaneous nodule, often on the head or neck.

Pilomatrixoma (Pilomatricoma)

A usually benign, firm skin tumor arising from hair-matrix cells, most often on the head, neck, or upper limbs of children and young adults. It may be mistaken for a cyst; excision confirms the diagnosis and is usually curative.

Pilonidal Cyst

A cyst or sinus in the cleft between the buttocks, usually containing hair and skin debris. It may become infected, painful, swollen, and drain pus.

Alternate Names:
Pilonidal Sinus; Sacrococcygeal Fistula

Pilonidal Dimple

Alternate name; see *Sacral Dimple*.

Pilonidal Disease

A condition in which hair and skin debris collect in a small pit or tunnel in the cleft between the buttocks. It can cause repeated swelling, pain, drainage, or an abscess.

Pilonidal Fistula

An abnormal tunnel from a pilonidal sinus to the

skin, usually in the natal cleft, that can drain pus or recur after abscess formation.

Pilonidal Sinus Disease

A chronic sinus or cyst in the natal cleft, usually containing hair and debris. It may cause recurrent pain, swelling, drainage, or abscess formation.

Pilus

A tiny hair-like structure on some bacteria. It may help bacteria attach to human cells, move, or transfer genetic material to other bacteria, which can contribute to infection or antibiotic resistance.

Pimozide

An antipsychotic medicine used for selected disorders involving severe tics or abnormal thoughts. It can cause movement problems, sleepiness, and dangerous heart-rhythm changes, so dosing and heart monitoring require careful medical supervision.

Pimple

A common lay term for a small inflamed or blocked skin lesion, often an acne papule or pustule.

Pimples (Acne)

Alternate name; see *Acne*.

Pin Care

Pin care keeps the skin around external fixation or traction pins clean and monitored for redness, swelling, drainage, loosening, or infection.

Pinched Nerve

Compression or irritation of a nerve that can cause pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness along the nerve's distribution.

Alternate Names:
Compressed Nerve; Nerve Compression; Radiculopathy

Pinch Strength

Pinch strength is the force produced when the thumb presses against one or more fingers and can help assess hand, nerve, muscle, and functional impairment.

Pindolol

Pindolol is a beta-blocker used for selected cardiovascular conditions; it can slow the heart rate and worsen asthma in susceptible people.

Pineal Cyst

A fluid-filled sac in the small gland deep in the brain that helps regulate sleep-related signals. Most are found incidentally and cause no harm, but a large cyst can rarely cause headache, eye problems, or fluid buildup.

Pineal Germinoma

A pineal germinoma is a malignant germ-cell tumor in the pineal region, often causing headache, eye-movement abnormalities, or hydrocephalus and usually responsive to radiotherapy and chemotherapy.

Pineal Gland

A small hormone-producing gland deep in the brain that releases melatonin. Melatonin helps coordinate the body's day-night clock and influences sleep timing, seasonal rhythms, and related biological functions.

Pineal Gland Tumor

A growth in or near the pineal gland. It may block the normal flow of brain fluid and cause headache, nausea, vomiting, sleepiness, or problems moving the eyes; symptoms and treatment depend on its type and size.

Pinealoma

An older, imprecise term for a tumor in or near the pineal gland. Such tumors include several different types, so the specific diagnosis depends on imaging and tissue examination.

Pineal Parenchymal Tumor

A tumor arising from cells of the pineal gland, ranging from slow-growing to aggressive. It may block the flow of brain fluid and cause headache, vomiting,

sleep changes, or abnormal eye movements.

Pineoblastoma

An aggressive cancer in the pineal region of the brain, occurring mainly in children. It may block brain-fluid flow and cause headache, vomiting, sleepiness, or eye-movement problems.

Pineocytoma

Pineocytoma is a usually slow-growing tumor of pineal cells that may obstruct cerebrospinal-fluid flow and cause raised intracranial pressure.

Pine Oil Poisoning

Swallowing or inhaling concentrated pine oil can irritate the mouth and stomach and may cause drowsiness, seizures, or lung injury if it enters the lungs.

Pinguecula

A benign yellowish, raised deposit on the conjunctiva near the edge of the cornea. It does not grow onto the cornea and is associated with long-term exposure to ultraviolet light, wind, and dust; it may cause irritation.

Pinhole Meatus

An unusually tiny external opening, most often the opening of the urethra. It can make urine flow weak or spraying, cause discomfort, or make catheter placement difficult.

Pink Eye

A common name for conjunctivitis, inflammation of the eye covering causing redness, irritation, watering, or discharge.

Alternate Names:
Conjunctival Inflammation; Acute Conjunctivitis

Pink Puffer

An older, nonformal term for a person with emphysema who has severe breathlessness, a thin build, and pursed-lip breathing. The term is not a separate diagnosis and is less useful than describing the person's COPD and test results.

Pinna

The visible external part of the ear that collects sound.

Pinocytosis

A process in which a cell takes in small drops of surrounding fluid and dissolved substances. The cell membrane folds inward to form tiny bubbles that carry the material inside for use, transport, or breakdown.

Pins and Needles

A common name for paresthesia, an abnormal tingling, prickling, or numb sensation. Brief episodes often follow pressure on a nerve; persistent symptoms can occur with nerve or circulation disorders.

Pint

A unit of volume whose exact amount varies by measurement system; a US liquid pint and an imperial pint are different volumes.

Pinta

A long-lasting skin infection caused by Treponema carateum bacteria. It spreads through close skin contact and produces changing stages of discolored, scaly, or thickened patches, usually without damage to internal organs.

Pinworm

A small, parasitic nematode (*Enterobius vermicularis*) that infects the human gastrointestinal tract, especially in young children. Female worms migrate out through the anus at night to deposit eggs in the perianal skin, causing intense nocturnal pruritus ani, excoriation, and restlessness. Transmission occurs via the fecal-oral route by ingestion of infective eggs on contaminated hands, clothing, or bedsheets. Diagnosis is made using the cellophane tape test, and treatment involves anthelmintics (pyrantel pamoate, albendazole, or mebendazole) administered to the patient and household contacts in two doses spaced two weeks apart.

Alternate Names:
Pinworms; Enterobius vermicularis; Enterobiasis; Threadworm

Pinworm Infection

Pinworm infection is an intestinal infestation by Enterobius vermicularis, causing nighttime anal itching, disturbed sleep, and sometimes abdominal or genital irritation. Treatment of the person and close household contacts, hygiene, and repeat dosing reduce reinfection.

Alternate Names:
Enterobiasis; Oxyuriasis; Threadworm Infection

Pinworm Infestation

Alternate name; see *Pinworm Infection*.

Pinworms

Plural form; see *Pinworm*.

Pinworm Test

A test for Enterobius vermicularis, usually the early-morning adhesive-tape test applied to the perianal skin before bathing or defecation.

Pioglitazone

A medicine for type 2 diabetes that helps muscle and fat cells respond better to insulin, lowering blood sugar. It can cause weight gain and swelling and may worsen heart failure, so it is unsuitable for some people.

Piperacillin

Piperacillin is an extended-spectrum penicillin antibiotic often combined with tazobactam to treat serious infections including Pseudomonas; allergy, diarrhoea, cytopenias, electrolyte effects, and renal dosing are important.

Piperazine

An older antiparasitic medicine that paralyzes certain intestinal worms, especially roundworms and pinworms. Its use depends on local guidance and the particular infection.

Piperonyl Butoxide

A pesticide synergist that inhibits insect detoxification enzymes and increases the activity of certain insecticides; it can irritate skin, eyes, or airways.

Piperonyl Butoxide With Pyrethrins Poisoning

Exposure to these insecticide ingredients can irritate the skin, eyes, or airways and may cause coughing, nausea, vomiting, dizziness, or wheezing. Severe exposure can cause breathing difficulty or systemic toxicity.

Pipotiazine

A long-acting phenothiazine antipsychotic given by injection in selected settings. It can cause movement disorders, drowsiness, and other adverse effects, particularly with prolonged exposure.

Pipradrol

An older central nervous system stimulant with limited current use.

Piracetam

A nootropic compound used in some countries for selected neurologic indications; evidence and approval vary.

PI-RADS

A standard scoring system for prostate MRI findings. It estimates how likely an area is to contain an important prostate cancer and helps guide decisions about follow-up or biopsy; it does not diagnose cancer by itself.

Pirfenidone

Pirfenidone is an antifibrotic medicine used to slow decline in idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis; nausea, photosensitivity, fatigue, and liver-enzyme elevation may occur and require monitoring.

Piriformis Syndrome

Pain or altered sensation in the buttock or down the leg when the piriformis muscle irritates or presses on the sciatic nerve. Similar symptoms can result from other causes, especially spinal nerve disorders.

Alternate Names:
Piriformis Muscle Spasm; Deep Gluteal Syndrome

Pirimicarb

Pirimicarb is a selective carbamate insecticide targeting aphids; exposure can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic symptoms.

Piromidic Acid

An older quinolone-like antibacterial investigated or used for urinary and gastrointestinal infections; current use depends on local availability, susceptibility, and safety guidance.

Piroxicam

A long-acting nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain and inflammation; gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, cardiovascular events, and hypersensitivity are important risks.

Piroxicam Overdose

Taking too much piroxicam, an anti-inflammatory pain medicine, can cause stomach pain, vomiting, bleeding, kidney injury, drowsiness, seizures, or breathing problems. Large or intentional overdoses can be life-threatening.

Pisa Syndrome

A sustained involuntary sideways flexion of the trunk, often associated with medicines, Parkinson disease, or other neurologic disorders.

Pisiform

A small, pea-shaped wrist bone embedded in a tendon on the little-finger side of the palm. It helps form the passageway for the ulnar nerve and artery and may hurt after injury or with arthritis.

Pisiform Bone

A small pea-shaped carpal bone embedded in the tendon of flexor carpi ulnaris on the ulnar side of the wrist; fracture or arthritis can cause localized wrist pain.

Pits

Small depressions or holes in a surface. In medicine, pits may occur in nails, skin, teeth, or other tissues and can result from normal anatomy, injury, infection, inflammation, or inherited conditions.

Pitted Keratolysis

A superficial, non-inflammatory bacterial infection of the stratum corneum of the plantar foot (most commonly caused by *Kytococcus sedentarius* or *Corynebacterium* species), presenting with punched-out superficial crateriform pits, hyperhidrosis, and severe sulfurous malodor (bromhidrosis).

Pitting Edema

Swelling in which pressure applied to the skin leaves a temporary indentation, usually because of excess interstitial fluid.

Pituicytoma

A rare, usually slow-growing tumor near the pituitary gland. It may cause headache, vision problems, or hormone disturbances by pressing on nearby structures and is usually assessed with brain imaging and tissue examination.

Pituitary

The pituitary is an endocrine gland at the base of the brain that releases hormones controlling growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, and water balance.

Pituitary Adenoma

A usually noncancerous growth arising from the front part of the pituitary gland. It may release too much of a hormone or press on nearby tissue, causing headache, vision changes, or hormone problems.

Pituitary Apoplexy

Sudden bleeding or loss of blood supply inside a pituitary growth, causing severe headache, vision changes, vomiting, eye-movement problems, or confusion. It is an emergency because hormone failure can cause life-threatening low blood pressure.

Pituitary Carcinoma

Pituitary carcinoma is a rare malignant pituitary tumor defined by spread to distant or separate sites, often producing excess hormones.

Pituitary Disease

A disorder of the pituitary gland that alters hormone secretion or causes mass effects, including adenomas, inflammation, hemorrhage, genetic disease, or hypopituitarism.

Pituitary Dwarfism

Pituitary dwarfism is severe short stature caused by deficient growth hormone or broader pituitary dysfunction, with evaluation focused on endocrine and genetic causes.

Pituitary Gland

Also called the hypophysis, this pea-sized gland sits at the base of the brain beneath the hypothalamus. Its front part (anterior pituitary) grows from Rathke's pouch and makes six hormones: growth hormone, adrenocorticotropic hormone, thyroid-stimulating hormone, prolactin, follicle-stimulating hormone, and luteinizing hormone. Signals from the hypothalamus reach it through portal blood vessels. Its back part (posterior pituitary) develops from brain tissue and stores and releases antidiuretic hormone and oxytocin, made in the hypothalamus, which help control water balance, childbirth, and milk release.

Pituitary Hormone

A hormone secreted by the anterior or posterior pituitary that regulates growth, thyroid and adrenal function, reproduction, lactation, water balance, or other endocrine organs.

Pituitary Insufficiency

Alternate name; see *Hypopituitarism*.

Pituitary Macroadenoma

A pituitary adenoma measuring at least 10 mm. It may compress the optic chiasm and cause visual-field loss or headache, or alter pituitary hormone production; MRI, visual-field testing, and endocrine assessment are central to evaluation.

Pituitary Microadenoma

A pituitary adenoma smaller than 10 mm. It may be hormonally inactive and found incidentally or may produce prolactin, ACTH, growth hormone, or other hormones; evaluation depends on imaging and endocrine findings.

Pituitary Neoplasm

A pituitary neoplasm is an abnormal growth in or near the pituitary gland and may affect hormones, vision, or nearby brain structures.

Pituitary Neuroendocrine Tumor

Alternate name; see *Pituitary Tumor*.

Pituitary Tumor

A pituitary tumor is a growth in the pituitary gland that may be noncancerous but can cause hormone excess, hormone deficiency, or visual problems.

Pituitary Tumors Pathology

Pathologic assessment of pituitary neuroendocrine tumors, including cell lineage, hormone production, reticulin architecture, cytologic features, proliferative activity, and invasion. Immunohistochemistry helps classify the tumor.

Pityriasis

A group of skin conditions marked by fine, flaky scaling. Examples include pityriasis rosea and pityriasis versicolor, which have different causes and may produce itching or lighter, darker, or pink patches.

Pityriasis Alba

Pityriasis alba is a common benign skin condition causing faint, dry, lighter patches, especially on children's faces, often more noticeable after tanning.

Pityriasis Lichenoides

An uncommon inflammatory skin eruption of uncertain cause, producing recurrent crops of small scaly papules. Its spectrum ranges from a chronic form with reddish-brown lesions to an acute form with blisters, crusts, or ulcers.

Pityriasis Lichenoides Chronica

The chronic form of pityriasis lichenoides, causing recurrent crops of small, reddish-brown papules with

fine adherent scale. Lesions usually heal without scarring but may leave temporary light or dark marks.

Alternate Names:
PLC

Pityriasis Lichenoides Et Varioliformis Acuta

The acute form of pityriasis lichenoides (PLEVA), producing sudden crops of red-brown papules that may become blistered, necrotic, or crusted and heal with small varioliform scars. A rare febrile ulceronecrotic form is called Mucha-Habermann disease.

Alternate Names:
PLEVA

Pityriasis Rosea

An acute, usually self-limited rash of oval, scaly spots. It may start with one larger spot called a herald patch, followed days to weeks later by smaller spots along skin-cleavage lines on the trunk and nearby limbs, sometimes forming a Christmas-tree pattern on the back. The cause is unknown, and the rash usually clears within several weeks.

Alternate Names:
Pityriasis Rosea of Gibert; Christmas Tree Rash

Pityriasis Rubra Pilaris

A group of rare inflammatory skin disorders that cause well-defined, reddish-orange scaly patches and rough bumps around hair follicles. Patches may spread widely while leaving islands of normal skin. The palms and soles may become thick, yellowish, dry, and cracked. The course varies and may last for months or years.

Pityriasis Versicolor

An overgrowth of *Malassezia* yeasts, which normally live on the skin, in its outer layer. It causes finely scaling pale, darker, or pink patches, usually on the chest, back, neck, or upper arms. Pigment changes may persist after the yeast overgrowth has cleared, and the condition can recur.

Pivampicillin

An orally absorbed prodrug of ampicillin used for selected bacterial infections; its use is limited in some settings by adverse effects and availability.

Pivot Joint

A joint in which one bone rotates around another bone. The joints between the first two neck bones and parts of the forearm are examples.

Pixantrone

Pixantrone is an anthracenedione antineoplastic drug developed for selected aggressive lymphomas, with potential marrow, infection, and cardiac risks.

PJI

Alternate name; see *Periprosthetic Joint Infection*.

PJS

Alternate name; see *Peutz-Jeghers Syndrome*.

PKD

Alternate name; see *Polycystic Kidney Disease*.

Placebo

An inactive substance, treatment, or procedure designed to resemble an active treatment. In a clinical trial, it is given to a control group so researchers can compare outcomes and estimate the specific effect of the treatment being studied.

Alternate Names:
Sham Treatment; Inactive Control

Placebo Control

A placebo control is an inactive treatment designed to resemble the intervention in a clinical trial, helping separate treatment effects from expectation and natural change.

Placebo Effect

A real change in symptoms or wellbeing that can occur after a person receives an inactive treatment, partly because of expectations, attention, and the treatment setting. It does not prove that the inactive treatment changed the disease itself.

Placenta

The temporary organ connecting mother and fetus, allowing exchange of oxygen, nutrients, wastes, and hormones.

Placenta Abruptio

Placental abruption is premature separation of the placenta from the uterine wall, causing bleeding, abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fetal compromise, or maternal shock.

Placenta Accreta

Placenta accreta spectrum occurs when placental tissue abnormally attaches to or invades the uterine wall, creating major risk of hemorrhage during attempted delivery or removal.

Placenta Accreta Spectrum

Abnormal adherence or invasion of placental villi into the uterine wall, ranging from accreta to increta and percreta; it can cause severe postpartum hemorrhage and requires planned obstetric management.

Placenta Disorder

A disorder of placental implantation, structure, perfusion, or separation, including previa, accreta spectrum, abruption, infarction, or placental insufficiency.

Placenta Increta

Abnormal placental invasion into the myometrium without reaching the serosa, increasing the risk of massive hemorrhage at delivery and often requiring cesarean hysterectomy.

Placental Abnormalities

Disorders of placental location, attachment, structure, or separation that may affect pregnancy or cause bleeding.

Placental Abruption

Premature detachment of a normally implanted placenta from the uterine myometrium prior to delivery of the fetus, classically presenting with painful dark vaginal bleeding, uterine hypertonicity, and fetal distress.

Alternate Names:
Abruptio Placentae; Premature Placental Separation; Accidental Antepartum Hemorrhage

Placental Accreta Spectrum

Abnormal attachment of the placenta to the uterine wall, ranging from accreta (abnormally attached to the wall), to increta (growing into the uterine muscle), to percreta (growing through the wall and sometimes into nearby organs). A previous cesarean birth, especially with placenta previa, increases risk.

Placental Hormone

A hormone produced by placental tissue, such as hCG, progesterone, estrogens, or human placental lactogen, that supports pregnancy, fetal growth, and maternal metabolic adaptation.

Placental Infarction

A region of placental tissue damaged by inadequate maternal blood flow and coagulation, which may be incidental or, when extensive, associated with fetal growth restriction or pregnancy complications.

Placental Insufficiency

Placental insufficiency is inadequate placental delivery of oxygen and nutrients, which can cause fetal growth restriction, abnormal Doppler findings, reduced fluid, or fetal distress.

Placental Lactogen

Placental lactogen is a hormone made by the placenta that alters maternal metabolism and supports breast development and fetal nutrient availability during pregnancy.

Placental Mesenchymal Dysplasia

A rare abnormal development of the placenta in which supporting tissue becomes enlarged and cyst-like. It can resemble a molar pregnancy on scans and may be associated with poor fetal growth, fetal abnormalities, or pregnancy complications.

Placental Separation Signs

Clinical signs indicating the placenta has separated from the uterine wall and is ready for delivery. Classic signs: lengthening of the umbilical cord (cord lengthens as the placenta descends), a sudden gush of blood, and uterine elevation and firming (the uterus rises and becomes globular as the placenta moves into the lower segment).

Placental Site Nodule

A benign, usually incidental remnant of intermediate trophoblast at a prior implantation site, composed of small nests of chorionic-type or extravillous trophoblast.

Placenta Percreta

Placenta percreta is the most invasive form of placenta accreta spectrum, with villi growing through the uterine wall and sometimes into nearby organs such as the bladder.

Placenta Praevia

Alternate spelling; see *Placenta Previa*.

Placenta Previa

A condition in which the placenta covers the opening of the cervix. It can cause painless bleeding in the second half of pregnancy and may make vaginal birth unsafe. A placenta near, but not covering, the opening is called low-lying placenta.

Placentation

The developmental process by which the placenta forms and attaches to the uterus, establishes maternal–fetal circulation, and develops the exchange and endocrine functions needed for pregnancy.

Plagiocephaly

Asymmetric flattening of an infant's skull. The common positional form develops from repeated pressure on one area; rare skull-shape changes from early fusion of a cranial suture are called synostotic plagiocephaly.

Alternate Names:
Flat Head Syndrome; Deformational Plagiocephaly

Plague

A serious infection caused by Yersinia pestis, transmitted mainly by infected fleas or respiratory droplets in pneumonic disease.

Plain Radiography

An imaging method that uses X-rays to create a two-dimensional projection of internal structures. It is used to assess bones, the chest, abdomen, teeth, and other selected body regions.

Alternate Names:
Roentgenography; Projection Radiography

Planar

Flat or arranged in one plane. In medical imaging, the term describes a two-dimensional view or projection, unlike three-dimensional imaging that shows depth and allows reconstruction from multiple directions.

Plane Joint

A joint with mostly flat surfaces that slide over one another. Small movements occur in several directions, as in some wrist and foot joints.

Plantar

Relating to the sole or underside of the foot, including the plantar surfaces of the toes.

Plantar Fasciitis

Pain from irritation and small injuries in the strong band of tissue supporting the sole of the foot. Heel pain is often worst with the first steps after waking or resting and may worsen after prolonged standing.

Plantar Fibromatosis

A benign overgrowth of fibrous tissue in the plantar fascia that forms firm nodules in the sole of the foot. It may be painless or cause pressure pain while walking; treatment depends on symptoms and can include footwear changes, injections, or surgery.

Plantar Flexion

Downward movement of the foot at the ankle, pointing the toes away from the shin. It is produced mainly by the calf muscles and is used in standing on tiptoe, walking, running, and jumping.

Plantar Hyperhidrosis

Alternate name; see *Hyperhidrosis*.

Plantaris Muscle

A small posterior-leg muscle with a long tendon that assists weakly with knee flexion and plantar flexion; it can be strained during sudden athletic movement.

Plantar Nerve

A nerve supplying sensation to the sole of the foot and motor branches to intrinsic foot muscles; compression can cause burning pain, numbness, or altered toe movement.

Plantar Neuroma

Alternate name; see *Morton Neuroma*.

Plantar Reflex

Movement of the toes after the sole of the foot is gently stroked. In most adults the toes bend downward; upward movement of the big toe may indicate a problem in brain or spinal nerve pathways controlling movement.

Plantar Response

Movement of the toes and foot after the sole is stimulated. The pattern helps clinicians assess pathways between the brain, spinal cord, and leg; an unusual upward movement of the big toe in an adult may indicate neurologic disease.

Plantar Wart

A wart on the sole of the foot caused by human papillomavirus. Pressure from standing and walking can push it inward and make it painful; small black dots may represent tiny clotted blood vessels.

Alternate Names:
Foot Wart

Plant Fertilizer Poisoning

Fertilizer exposure may irritate the mouth, skin, eyes, stomach, or lungs. Some products can dangerously alter blood oxygen or body salts; keep the container and contact poison control after swallowing or significant exposure.

Plant Poisoning

Illness caused by eating, touching, or inhaling a toxic plant or plant product; effects range from local irritation to organ failure.

Plant Thorn Arthritis

Plant thorn arthritis is persistent joint inflammation after a thorn puncture introduces plant material, sometimes requiring removal of foreign material and treatment of infection or inflammation.

Plant Thorn Synovitis

Inflammation of a joint after penetration by a plant thorn or splinter, sometimes involving an infection introduced by the injury. Symptoms may develop gradually as persistent joint pain, swelling, and limited movement; evaluation may require removal of retained material and targeted treatment.

Alternate Names:
Thorn-Induced Arthritis; Foreign Body Synovitis

Plaque

A localized buildup or raised area of material. In the skin, a plaque is a broad, raised lesion often formed by joined papules; in an artery, plaque is a fatty deposit in the vessel wall that can narrow the artery.

Plaque And Tartar On Teeth

Dental plaque is a bacterial biofilm that forms on teeth, while tartar is hardened mineralized plaque; both contribute to cavities, gingivitis, and periodontitis.

Plaque Assay

A laboratory test that estimates the number of infectious virus particles in a sample. The sample is placed on living cells, and each infectious particle

may produce a visible area of damaged cells that can be counted.

Plaque Psoriasis

The most common form of psoriasis, producing well-demarcated raised red plaques with silvery scale, commonly on elbows, knees, scalp, and lower back and sometimes associated with arthritis.

Plasma

The liquid part of blood carrying cells, proteins, nutrients, hormones, wastes, and other dissolved substances through the body.

Plasma Amino Acids

A blood test that measures amino acids in plasma. It can help evaluate inherited metabolic disorders, poor nutrition, liver disease, or other conditions affecting amino-acid processing.

Plasmablastic Lymphoma

Plasmablastic lymphoma is an aggressive B-cell lymphoma often associated with immune deficiency, HIV infection, or immunosuppression.

Plasma Cell

A fully differentiated, terminally mature B lymphocyte specialized for the synthesis and high-level secretion of antigen-specific antibodies (immunoglobulins). Characterized cytologically by an eccentric nucleus with a clock-face or cartwheel chromatin pattern, abundant basophilic cytoplasm, and a prominent pale perinuclear Golgi apparatus. Neoplastic proliferation of clonal plasma cells gives rise to plasma cell dyscrasias, including monoclonal gammopathy of undetermined significance (MGUS) and multiple myeloma.

Alternate Names:
Plasma Cells; Effector B Cell

Plasma Cell Mastitis

A chronic benign inflammatory breast lesion with prominent plasma-cell infiltration, often involving ducts beneath the nipple and potentially causing a mass, nipple retraction, or discharge. It can clinically mimic carcinoma.

Plasma Cell Myeloma

A cancer of antibody-producing plasma cells, usually in the bone marrow. It can produce an abnormal antibody and damage bones, kidneys, blood-cell production, or calcium balance, causing bone pain, fractures, anemia, infections, or kidney problems.

Plasma Cell Neoplasm

A clonal disorder of antibody-producing plasma cells, ranging from localized plasmacytoma to multiple myeloma with marrow, bone, kidney, calcium, or blood abnormalities.

Plasma Cells

Plural form; see *Plasma Cell*.

Plasma Concentration

The amount of a substance present in a defined volume of plasma at a given time. It is used to interpret exposure, toxicity, therapeutic drug monitoring, and pharmacokinetic relationships.

Plasmacytoma

A solitary mass of neoplastic plasma cells, which may occur in bone (solitary plasmacytoma of bone) or soft tissue (extramedullary plasmacytoma). It can progress to multiple myeloma.

Plasma Expanders

Fluids given through a vein to increase circulating blood volume. Crystalloid solutions are commonly used, while selected colloids have limited roles; treatment depends on the cause of fluid loss and patient condition.

Plasma Kallikrein

A blood enzyme that helps produce bradykinin, a substance that widens blood vessels and increases leakage from them. It contributes to inflammation and swelling and is involved in some inherited swelling disorders.

Plasmalogen

A special type of fat found in cell membranes, especially in the brain, nerves, and heart. The body

makes it partly in structures called peroxisomes; very low levels occur in some inherited metabolic disorders.

Plasma Membrane

The selectively permeable lipid bilayer surrounding a cell, containing proteins that control transport, signaling, adhesion, recognition, and communication with the extracellular environment.

Plasma Osmolarity

The concentration of dissolved particles in the liquid part of blood. It mainly reflects water balance and substances such as sodium, glucose, and urea; abnormal values can indicate dehydration, excess water, or metabolic disease.

Plasmapheresis

A procedure that separates plasma from blood cells. In therapeutic plasma exchange, plasma is removed and replaced with a suitable fluid; this can treat selected immune, blood, and neurologic disorders. Plasma may also be collected from donors.

Alternate Names:
Therapeutic Plasma Exchange; TPE; Plasma Exchange; Apheresis

Plasma Substitutes

Intravenous fluids intended to expand plasma volume, including crystalloids and colloid solutions; choice depends on the clinical indication and risks.

Plasma / Urine Catecholamine Assay

Blood or urine tests measuring catecholamines or their breakdown products. They may help investigate pheochromocytoma or paraganglioma, but medicines, stress, posture, diet, and collection conditions can affect results.

Alternate Names:
Fractionated Catecholamines; Free Metanephrines

Plasmid

A small, circular, extrachromosomal DNA molecule within a bacterium or other microorganism that can replicate autonomously of genomic chromosomal DNA. Plasmids frequently carry accessory genes that confer selective survival advantages, such as antibiotic resistance factors, virulence determinants, or heavy metal tolerance, and are readily transferred horizontally between bacteria via conjugation, transformation, or transduction.

Alternate Names:
Plasmids

Plasmids

Plural form; see *Plasmid*.

Plasmin

An enzyme that breaks down fibrin, the protein mesh holding a blood clot together. It is formed from plasminogen and helps remove clots after a damaged blood vessel has been repaired.

Plasminogen

An inactive blood protein that can be changed into plasmin, an enzyme that breaks down the protein framework of blood clots. The body activates it when a clot needs to be removed.

Plasminogen Activator

An enzyme or medicine that changes plasminogen into plasmin, which breaks down the protein mesh of blood clots. These medicines can dissolve dangerous clots but may cause serious bleeding.

Plasminogen Inactivators

Substances or medicines that reduce the conversion of plasminogen into plasmin, thereby slowing breakdown of blood clots. They may be used or studied when limiting bleeding is important.

Plasmodium

A group of parasites spread through bites from infected Anopheles mosquitoes and responsible for malaria. The parasites first infect the liver, then red blood cells, causing fever and potentially severe organ complications.

Plasmodium Vivax

A parasite spread by infected Anopheles mosquitoes

that causes malaria. It infects red blood cells and can remain dormant in the liver, allowing illness to return months or years after the first infection.

Plasmodium Vivax Malaria

Malaria caused by the parasite Plasmodium vivax and spread by infected mosquitoes. Fever attacks may recur about every two days, and dormant liver forms can cause later relapses; treatment must clear both blood and liver stages when safe.

Alternate Names:
Vivax Malaria; Benign Tertian Malaria

Plaster Of Paris

A powder that hardens when mixed with water. In healthcare it is used to make casts and splints that hold an injured bone or joint still while it heals; swelling, numbness, or increasing pain under a cast can indicate pressure-related injury.

Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery

Surgery that restores form or function after congenital difference, injury, disease, or removal of tissue.

Plastic Bronchitis

A rare condition producing large, branching mucous casts that form in the airways, causing life-threatening airway obstruction, often associated with congenital heart disease or post-fontan circulation.

Plastic Casting Resin Poisoning

Exposure to uncured casting resin or its solvents can irritate or burn the skin, eyes, lungs, and digestive tract. Swallowing or breathing fumes may cause vomiting, dizziness, or lung injury and requires poison-control advice.

Plastic Resin Hardener Poisoning

Resin hardeners may contain corrosive or irritating chemicals that burn the skin, eyes, mouth, throat, or stomach. Fumes can injure the lungs, and substantial exposure can cause systemic toxicity.

Plastic Surgery

A surgical specialty that repairs, reconstructs, or reshapes body tissues to restore or alter form and function. Its name comes from the Greek *plastikos*, meaning "to mold" or "give form," and is unrelated to synthetic plastic. Reconstructive procedures address congenital defects, injury, disease, or tissue loss after tumor removal; cosmetic procedures reshape normal structures to change appearance. The specialty encompasses procedures throughout the body.

Platelet

A small, anucleate, discoid cellular fragment derived from bone marrow megakaryocytes that plays an indispensable role in primary hemostasis and vascular repair. Circulating with a normal lifespan of 7–10 days, platelets adhere to exposed subendothelial collagen via von Willebrand factor, undergo activation and granule release (ADP, thromboxane A_2, serotonin), and aggregate via glycoprotein IIb/IIIa receptors to form a primary hemostatic plug while providing a catalytic phospholipid surface for the coagulation cascade.

Alternate Names:
Platelets; Thrombocyte; Thrombocytes

Platelet Aggregation

The clumping of platelets at an injured blood vessel to form an early plug that helps stop bleeding.

Platelet Aggregation Test

A laboratory test measuring platelet clumping in response to agonists such as ADP, collagen, or epinephrine, used to evaluate platelet function disorders and medication effects.

Platelet Antibodies Blood Test

A blood test detecting antibodies directed against platelet antigens, used selectively in suspected immune thrombocytopenia, neonatal alloimmune thrombocytopenia, or platelet-transfusion refractoriness.

Platelet Count

The number of platelets in a given volume of blood,

used to assess bleeding or clotting risk.

Platelet Function Assay

An automated in vitro laboratory test measuring primary platelet-related hemostasis under high shear stress conditions, determining the closure time required for platelets in citrated whole blood to occlude an aperture coated with collagen/epinephrine or collagen/ADP.

Alternate Names:
PFA-100

Platelet Function Disorders

Conditions in which platelets do not adhere, activate, or aggregate normally, causing impaired primary hemostasis. They may be inherited or acquired and can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or bleeding after procedures.

Platelet Plug Formation

The first step in stopping bleeding after a blood vessel is injured. Platelets attach to the damaged area, become active, and clump together to form a temporary plug.

Alternate Names:
Primary Hemostasis; Platelet Aggregation

Platelet-Rich Plasma

A preparation made by concentrating platelets from a person's own blood and injecting it into a selected tissue. It releases growth factors and is used in some musculoskeletal, wound, and hair-loss treatments, but evidence and benefit vary by condition and technique.

Platelets

Plural form; see *Platelet*.

Platybasia

An unusually flattened base of the skull. It may cause no symptoms, but in some people it narrows the space around the lower brain or spinal cord and contributes to headache, imbalance, weakness, or other nerve problems.

Platypnea

Dyspnea that occurs in the upright position and is relieved by lying down. It is the opposite of orthopnea. It is rare and may be associated with hepatopulmonary syndrome, intracardiac shunting, or pulmonary arteriovenous malformations.

Platypnea-Orthodeoxia Syndrome

A clinical syndrome characterized by dyspnea (platypnea) and arterial oxygen desaturation (orthodeoxia) that are precipitated or worsened when assuming an upright seated or standing posture and relieved in the recumbent (supine) position, typically caused by a posture-dependent intracardiac right-to-left shunt through a patent foramen ovale or pulmonary AVMs.

Alternate Names:
Orthodeoxia; Postural Shunt Hypoxemia

Platysma

A thin superficial muscle of the neck that tenses the skin and assists lower-jaw and lower-lip movement.

Pleiotropic Cytokine

An immune-signaling protein that affects several types of cells or produces more than one effect, such as changing inflammation, blood-cell production, immune activity, or tissue repair.

Pleiotropy

The ability of one gene change to influence several traits or body systems. For example, one inherited disorder may affect the brain, skin, blood, and other organs at the same time.

Pleomorphic

Pleomorphic means having multiple forms or marked variation in cell or tissue appearance; in pathology, it may be a feature of malignancy but is not diagnostic alone.

Pleomorphic Adenoma

A usually noncancerous tumor of a salivary gland, most often the parotid gland near the ear. It usually grows slowly as a painless lump, but long-standing

tumors can rarely become cancerous.

Alternate Names:
Benign Mixed Tumor

Pleomorphic Adenoma Of The Vulva

An exceptionally rare benign mixed epithelial and mesenchymal tumor of the vulva, resembling pleomorphic adenoma of salivary tissue and requiring histopathologic confirmation.

Pleomorphic Adenoma Pathology

A usually benign salivary-gland neoplasm containing variable epithelial and myoepithelial elements in a chondromyxoid, myxoid, or cartilaginous-appearing stroma. Incomplete excision and long duration increase recurrence or malignant-transformation risk.

Pleomorphic Dermal Sarcoma

An uncommon high-grade cutaneous sarcoma, usually on chronically sun-damaged skin of older adults, composed of markedly pleomorphic cells and capable of local recurrence or metastasis.

Pleomorphic Xanthoastrocytoma

A circumscribed astrocytic tumor, often arising superficially in the cerebral hemispheres of younger patients and associated with seizures. Most are low grade, but anaplastic transformation can occur.

Pleomorphism

Variation in the size and shape of cells or their nuclei within a tissue. Marked pleomorphism is a feature of many high-grade malignancies but can also occur in some reactive or degenerative conditions.

Plethoric

Plethoric means unusually full, congested, or ruddy, often describing the appearance associated with increased blood volume or red-cell mass.

Plethysmography

A test that measures changes in the size of a body part or the amount of blood or air it contains. It can assess circulation in the limbs, lung volume, or changes in blood flow during breathing or exercise.

Pleura

The thin, double-layered membrane around each lung. The visceral layer covers the lung; the parietal layer lines the chest cavity, including the diaphragm. A small amount of fluid between the layers reduces friction as the lungs move during breathing.

Pleural

Relating to the pleura, the membranes surrounding the lungs and lining the inside of the chest.

Pleural Cavity

The narrow space between the two slippery layers surrounding each lung. A small amount of fluid normally allows smooth breathing, while extra air, blood, pus, or fluid can restrict lung expansion.

Pleural Decortication

An operation that removes a thick scar-like layer from the lung's covering so a trapped lung can expand again. It may be used for long-standing infected fluid, blood, or inflammation around the lung when other treatment is insufficient. Risks include bleeding, infection, air leakage, and breathing complications.

Alternate Names:
Decortication of the Lung; Pulmonary Decortication; Thoracoscopic Decortication

Pleural Effusion

An abnormal buildup of fluid in the space between a lung and the chest wall. It may result from heart failure, infection, inflammation, cancer, or injury, and can cause shortness of breath, cough, or chest pain.

Pleural Fluid Analysis

Laboratory testing of fluid collected from around the lung. Cell counts, protein, acidity, glucose, cultures, and other tests help determine whether the fluid is caused by infection, cancer, heart failure, inflammation, or another problem.

Pleural Fluid Culture

Culture of pleural fluid to detect bacteria, fungi, or

mycobacteria in suspected pleural-space infection; specimens should be collected appropriately, often in blood-culture bottles.

Pleural Fluid Glucose

Pleural-fluid glucose may be reduced in empyema, complicated parapneumonic effusion, rheumatoid pleuritis, tuberculosis, and malignancy. It is interpreted with pH, cell count, protein, LDH, microbiology, imaging, and the clinical setting.

Pleural Fluid Gram Stain

A pleural-fluid Gram stain looks for bacteria in fluid around the lung and may support evaluation of empyema or bacterial pleural infection.

Pleural Fluid PH

Pleural-fluid pH helps assess infection and other causes of effusion. A markedly low pH supports a complicated parapneumonic effusion in the appropriate clinical setting, but drainage decisions also depend on imaging, fluid appearance, microbiology, glucose, and the patient's condition.

Pleural Fluid Smear

Microscopic examination of fluid removed from the space around the lung. It may show inflammatory cells, bacteria, fungi, cancer cells, or other material and is interpreted with fluid chemistry, cultures, imaging, and symptoms.

Pleural Friction Rub

A scratchy or grating sound heard through a stethoscope when inflamed layers around the lung rub together during breathing. It may occur with infection, a blood clot in the lung, or other causes of pleural inflammation.

Pleural Mesothelioma

A cancer arising from the pleura, the thin lining around the lungs and inner chest wall. It is strongly associated with asbestos exposure and may cause chest pain, breathlessness, or fluid around the lung.

Pleural Needle Biopsy

A pleural needle biopsy removes a small sample of the pleural lining through a needle for evaluation of cancer, infection, or inflammation.

Pleural Neoplasm

A pleural neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the lining around the lung, such as mesothelioma or metastatic cancer.

Pleural Perforation

A breach in the pleural lining allowing air or fluid to enter the pleural space, potentially causing pneumothorax or hydropneumothorax, often from trauma, procedures, or underlying lung disease.

Pleural Plaque

A usually harmless area of thickened or calcified tissue on the lining around the lung, most often caused by past asbestos exposure. It is not the same as asbestos-related lung scarring.

Pleural Rub

A rough, creaking or grating auscultatory sound heard during both inspiration and expiration, caused by the friction between roughened, inflamed visceral and parietal pleura. It is heard in pleuritis, pulmonary infarction, or pneumonia and ceases when the patient holds their breath.

Alternate Names:
Pleural Friction Rub

Pleural Sac

The potential space and enclosing pleural membranes around a lung, normally containing a small amount of lubricating fluid.

Pleural Space

The narrow potential space between the lung's inner covering and the chest wall's lining. It normally contains a small amount of lubricating fluid; air, blood, or excess fluid can impair breathing.

Pleural Tuberculosis

Tuberculous infection or inflammation of the pleura,

often producing a lymphocyte-rich pleural effusion, chest pain, fever, and breathlessness and requiring microbiologic or tissue evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Tuberculous Pleural Effusion; Tubercular Pleural Effusion; Pleural Effusion, Tubercular; Tuberculous Pleurisy

Pleurectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the pleura, used in the treatment of malignant pleural mesothelioma and recurrent malignant pleural effusion.

Pleurisy

Inflammation of the thin layers around the lungs, often causing sharp chest pain that worsens with deep breathing or coughing. Causes include viral infection, pneumonia, a blood clot, autoimmune disease, or injury; associated features vary with the underlying cause.

Alternate Names:
Pleuritic Chest Pain; Pleural Inflammation; Pleuritis

Pleuritic Pain

Sharp chest pain that worsens with breathing or coughing, often caused by inflammation of the pleura or nearby tissues.

Pleuritis

Alternate name; see *Pleurisy*.

Pleurodesis

A procedure that makes the two layers around a lung stick together so air or fluid cannot collect repeatedly. It may use a chemical or surgery and can cause pain, fever, infection, or breathing complications.

Pleurodynia

Severe, repeated pain in the chest or upper abdomen caused by inflammation of breathing muscles, often during infection with coxsackievirus. Pain may worsen with breathing or movement and usually resolves as infection improves.

Pleuropulmonary Blastoma

A rare aggressive childhood cancer arising in the lung or pleura, usually associated with DICER1-related tumor predisposition.

Plexiform Fibrohistiocytic Tumor

A rare low-grade malignant fibroblastic and histiocytic tumor, usually arising in the dermis or subcutis of the upper extremities of young people; local recurrence is common and metastasis is uncommon.

Plexiform Neurofibroma

A plexiform neurofibroma is a diffuse nerve-sheath tumor, strongly associated with neurofibromatosis type 1, that can grow along multiple nerve branches and sometimes become malignant.

Alternate Names:
PN PNF

Plexus

A network formed by intersecting nerves, blood vessels, lymphatic vessels, or other structures. Examples include the brachial nerve plexus and the celiac vascular plexus.

Pliability

Pliability is the ability of a material or tissue to bend, stretch, or deform without breaking; it is relevant to skin, vessels, lungs, and medical devices.

Plica

A fold of tissue, especially a fold in the lining of a joint. Plicae are often normal, but an irritated plica around the knee can cause pain, clicking, swelling, or a catching feeling with movement.

Plitidepsin

Plitidepsin is an antineoplastic compound that targets eukaryotic elongation factor 1A and has been studied for selected cancers and viral infections.

Ploidies

Ploidy describes the number of complete chromosome sets in a cell, such as haploid, diploid, or polyploid; abnormal ploidy can characterize tumors

or developmental disorders.

PLS
Alternate name; see *Primary Lateral Sclerosis*.

Plummer-Vinson Syndrome
A condition involving iron-deficiency anemia, difficulty swallowing, and thin webs in the upper swallowing tube. Treating the iron deficiency and stretching the web can improve swallowing and may reduce complications.

Pluralibacter Gergoviae
A gram-negative environmental bacterium that can contaminate medicines or cosmetics and rarely cause opportunistic infection.

Pluripotential
Able to develop into many, but not every, type of cell in the body. Pluripotent stem cells can produce cells from the three early tissue groups and are studied for development, disease, and regenerative treatment.

Plutonium
A radioactive heavy metal whose inhalation or ingestion can cause internal radiation exposure and toxicity.

Pm
An abbreviation that may mean afternoon, postmortem, or picometer; meaning depends on clinical context.

PMBCL
Alternate name; see *Mediastinal Lymphoma*.

PMBL
Alternate name; see *Mediastinal Lymphoma*.

PMDD
Premenstrual dysphoric disorder is a severe cyclic mood disorder occurring before menstruation with irritability, depression, anxiety, and functional impairment that improve after menses.

PML
PML commonly means progressive multifocal leukoencephalopathy, a JC-virus demyelinating brain infection during severe immune suppression, but it may have other meanings.

PMS
Abbreviation; see *Premenstrual Syndrome*.

PN
Alternate name; see *Plexiform Neurofibroma*.

Pneumatic
Relating to air or gas under pressure. Medical examples include an air-pressure ear examination, inflatable compression sleeves used to reduce clot risk, and an inflatable tourniquet used during some operations.

Pneumatic Otoscopy
Examination of the eardrum with a lighted instrument while gently changing the air pressure in the ear canal. Reduced eardrum movement may suggest fluid behind it or poor middle-ear ventilation.

Pneumatic Retinopexy
A procedure for selected retinal detachments in which an intravitreal gas bubble is injected and laser or cryotherapy seals the retinal break while positioning helps the bubble support the repair.

Pneumatic Tourniquet
An inflatable cuff used to temporarily reduce blood flow to a limb during surgery or selected procedures.

Pneumatocele
A thin-walled, air-filled space in the lung that often develops after infection, inflammation, or injury. Many resolve naturally, but large or infected spaces can impair breathing or require drainage or surgery.

Pneumatosis
Gas trapped within the wall of an organ or other tissue, most often the bowel. It may be harmless, but when caused by poor blood flow, infection, or

a tear, it can signal a life-threatening abdominal emergency.

Pneumatosis Cystoides Coli

Multiple gas-filled cysts within the wall of the large intestine. They may be harmless and found by chance, or may signal bowel blockage, poor blood flow, infection, or another serious illness when pain or other warning signs occur.

Pneumatosis Cystoides Intestinalis

Gas-filled cysts within the bowel wall. They may be harmless and found incidentally, but can also result from poor blood flow, infection, blockage, lung disease, or medicines. Severe pain, fever, or shock may indicate bowel injury.

Pneumatosis Intestinalis

Gas within the wall of the intestine, seen as small bubbles or lines on an imaging test. It may be harmless, but pain, fever, shock, or signs of poor blood flow may indicate bowel injury.

Pneumaturia

Passage of gas in urine. It may occur with an abnormal connection between the bowel and urinary tract or a gas-forming urinary infection. Recent bladder catheterization or other urinary instrumentation may also introduce air into the urinary tract and cause pneumaturia.

Pneumocephalus

Air or another gas inside the skull, usually after a head injury, brain surgery, or a skull fracture near the sinuses. A large or trapped collection can press on the brain and cause headache, vomiting, confusion, or reduced alertness.

Pneumococcal Infection

Infection caused by Streptococcus pneumoniae, ranging from ear or sinus infection to pneumonia, meningitis, or bloodstream infection.

Pneumococcal Infections (Streptococcus pneumoniae)

Infections caused by Streptococcus pneumoniae, ranging from otitis and sinusitis to pneumonia, bloodstream infection, and meningitis. Risk is increased by young or older age, absent spleen, chronic disease, smoking, or immune compromise; vaccination and prompt treatment reduce complications.

Pneumococcal Meningitis

A dangerous infection of the brain and spinal-cord coverings caused by Streptococcus pneumoniae. It can cause fever, headache, stiff neck, confusion, seizures, hearing loss, or death; treatment involves urgent antibiotics.

Pneumococcal Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by the bacterium Streptococcus pneumoniae. It can cause fever, cough, chest pain, and difficulty breathing; symptoms and imaging findings vary.

Alternate Names:
Streptococcus Pneumoniae Pneumonia; Pneumococcal Lung Infection

Pneumococcal Sepsis

Life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by the body's harmful response to infection with *Streptococcus pneumoniae*. It may arise from pneumococcal pneumonia, bloodstream infection, meningitis, or another invasive pneumococcal infection.

Pneumoconiosis

A group of work-related lung diseases caused by breathing mineral or industrial dust over time. Dust can scar lung tissue and cause cough, breathlessness, reduced oxygen, and progressive breathing disability.

Pneumocystis

A genus of fungi that includes Pneumocystis jirovecii, which can cause pneumonia in people with weakened cellular immunity.

Pneumocystis Infection

Infection by Pneumocystis jirovecii, most often caus-

ing pneumonia with dry cough, fever, and progressive shortness of breath in immunocompromised people.

Pneumocystis Jirovecii Pneumonia

A lung infection caused by the fungus *Pneumocystis jirovecii*. It mainly affects people with weakened immune defenses, including some people with HIV, cancer, or organ transplants, and people taking immune-suppressing medicines. It often causes gradually worsening shortness of breath, fever, and a dry cough; blood oxygen may become low.

Pneumocystis Pneumonia

Alternate name; see *Pneumocystis Jirovecii Pneumonia*.

Pneumocyte

A cell lining the air sacs of the lungs. Type I cells allow oxygen and carbon dioxide to pass between air and blood, while type II cells make surfactant, which helps keep the air sacs open.

Pneumolysis

Surgical separation or freeing of lung tissue or pleural adhesions.

Pneumomediastinum

Air trapped in the central space of the chest between the lungs. It may follow severe coughing, an injury, a medical procedure, or a tear in the airway or swallowing tube and can cause chest pain or breathlessness.

Pneumonectomy

Surgery to remove an entire lung. It is usually performed for selected lung cancers or severe one-sided lung disease when removing only part of the lung is not suitable.

Pneumonia

An acute infection of one or both lungs caused by bacteria, viruses, or fungi. The infection inflames the microscopic air sacs (alveoli) in the lungs, causing them to fill with fluid or pus. This impairs the lungs' ability to transfer oxygen into the bloodstream, resulting in symptoms such as fever, chills, a persistent cough producing phlegm, difficulty breathing, sharp chest pain when inhaling, and severe fatigue.

Pneumonia in Immunocompromised Patients

Lung infection in a person with impaired immune defenses from disease, medicines, transplantation, cancer, or other causes. The organism spectrum is broad, symptoms may be muted, and evaluation often requires early imaging, microbiologic testing, and tailored antimicrobial or supportive treatment.

Pneumonitis

Inflammation of lung tissue, often caused by a medicine, radiation, an immune reaction, inhaled irritants, or material entering the lungs rather than by infection. It may cause dry cough and breathlessness.

Pneumopericardium

Air around the heart, usually after a chest injury, surgery, a medical procedure, or a tear in the esophagus. A large or trapped collection can prevent the heart from filling and pumping properly, causing tamponade.

Pneumoperitoneum

Air or gas inside the abdominal cavity around the organs. It may be expected after abdominal surgery, but unexpected gas can indicate a torn intestine, especially when accompanied by pain or illness.

Pneumoplasty

Surgery to repair or reshape part of the lung or an airway. It may be used to remove a damaged area, improve airflow, or restore the shape of tissue after injury or disease.

Pneumotachometer

An instrument that measures the speed and amount of air moving during breathing. It can help assess airflow limitation and is used in lung-function testing, often together with other measurements.

Pneumothorax

Air in the space between the lung and chest wall (pleural space), which can partly or completely collapse the lung. It may happen spontaneously, after an injury, or after a medical procedure and can cause sudden chest pain or breathlessness; severe cases can impair circulation and breathing.

Pneumovirinae

Pneumovirinae is a subfamily of viruses that includes respiratory pathogens such as respiratory syncytial virus and human metapneumovirus.

Pneumovirus

A group or genus of respiratory viruses; human pneumovirus terminology often refers to human metapneumovirus or related paramyxoviruses.

PNF

Alternate name; see *Plexiform Neurofibroma*.

Pocket Erosion

Loss of tissue at the margin or base of a periodontal or surgical pocket, potentially exposing deeper structures and promoting infection, bleeding, or impaired healing.

Podagra

A sudden gout attack in the big-toe joint, causing intense pain, redness, warmth, and swelling.

Podiatric Surgery

Surgical treatment of conditions affecting the foot and ankle within the field of podiatry. Procedures may address deformity, injury, arthritis, infection, or other disorders; training and scope vary among jurisdictions.

Podiatrist

A healthcare professional specializing in diseases and injuries of the feet, ankles, and related lower limbs. Care may include examination, wound treatment, medicines, footwear advice, procedures, and prevention of complications.

Podiatry

The healthcare field focused on the feet, ankles, and related lower-limb conditions. It includes prevention, diagnosis, treatment, wound care, mobility support, and management of problems linked with diabetes or circulation.

Podocyte

A specialized cell covering the tiny blood vessels that filter blood in the kidney. Its delicate extensions help keep proteins in the bloodstream; damage can cause protein to leak into urine.

Podofilox

Podofilox is a topical antimitotic medicine used to treat selected external anogenital warts caused by human papillomavirus; irritation and correct application are important.

Podophyllin

Podophyllin is a plant-derived resin with antimitotic activity formerly used topically for warts; it can be severely toxic if absorbed and is generally replaced by safer products.

Podophyllum

A plant genus containing podophyllotoxin, used in some topical wart treatments but toxic if misused.

Podosome

A temporary attachment structure on the surface of some cells, including immune cells and bone-removing cells. It helps the cell grip tissue and break down nearby material while moving or carrying out its function.

POEMS Syndrome

A rare disorder linked to abnormal plasma cells that affects several body systems. It may cause nerve damage, enlarged organs, hormone problems, skin changes, fluid buildup, eye swelling, and unusual bone changes.

Alternate Names:
Crow-Fukase Syndrome

Poikilocytosis

The presence of red blood cells with unusually varied shapes on a blood smear. It may occur with anemia, inherited blood disorders, or damage to red blood cells.

Poikiloderma

A skin pattern combining mottled pigmentation, visible small vessels, and epidermal thinning, seen in connective-tissue disease, chronic sun damage, inflammation, and some cutaneous lymphomas.

Poikilotherm

An organism whose body temperature changes with surroundings, unlike humans, who normally maintain a relatively stable temperature.

Poinsettia Plant Exposure

Chewing poinsettia usually causes mild mouth irritation, nausea, or stomach upset, not severe poisoning. Rinse the mouth and contact poison control if symptoms are severe, a large amount was swallowed, or another product was involved.

Point

A specific location, spot, or value; in medicine it may refer to a tender point, pressure point, or measurement point.

Point Mutation

A change affecting one DNA building block. Depending on its location, it may have no effect, change the protein made by a gene, stop protein production early, or contribute to an inherited condition or cancer.

Point-Of-Care Testing

A test performed near the patient, such as in a clinic, ambulance, home, or hospital ward, instead of a central laboratory. Results are available quickly, but trained users, quality checks, and clinical interpretation remain essential.

Point-Of-Care Ultrasound

Ultrasound performed and interpreted at the bedside by the treating clinician to answer a focused question or guide a procedure. It can assess the heart, lungs, abdominal fluid, blood vessels, and bladder, but does not replace a complete imaging study when one is needed.

Poison

A substance that can cause injury, illness, or death when enough enters the body. Harm depends on the substance, amount, route, timing, and person's health.

Poison-Center Consultation

Specialist toxicology advice used to identify hazards, interpret exposure and laboratory data, select antidotes, guide observation or disposition, and coordinate public-health response. Consultation is appropriate for significant, uncertain, mixed, pediatric, or unusual exposures.

Poison Control

A specialist service that gives immediate advice after exposure to a medicine, chemical, plant, or other possible poison. They assess the substance and amount and advise on first aid, observation, emergency care, or further treatment.

Poison Control Emergency Services

Specialized regional 24-hour telephone triage and emergency clinical toxicological consultation services staffed by toxicologists and specialist nurses to guide immediate management of toxic ingestions, overdoses, bites, and chemical exposures.

Alternate Names:
Poison Helpline; Poison Control Hotline; Toxicological Emergency Consultation

Poisoning

Harmful effects caused by swallowing, inhaling, injecting, or absorbing a toxic substance. The effects depend on the substance, amount, route, timing, and person's health; inducing vomiting can worsen some poisonings.

Poisoning First Aid

Basic actions used after exposure to a toxic sub-

stance, such as leaving contaminated air and removing chemicals from skin or eyes. The correct response depends on the substance and route of exposure; inducing vomiting or giving food can worsen some poisonings.

Poison Ivy Rash

An itchy allergic contact dermatitis caused by exposure to urushiol, an oil found in poison ivy and related plants. The rash commonly appears as red streaks or patches with swelling, small bumps, or blisters; the pattern and severity vary with the amount and route of exposure.

Pokeweed Poisoning

Eating pokeweed, especially its roots or unripe parts, can cause burning in the mouth, vomiting, diarrhea, weakness, low blood pressure, or seizures. Severe exposure can cause cardiovascular or neurologic complications.

Poland Syndrome

A congenital condition characterized by absence or underdevelopment of part of the pectoral muscles on one side, sometimes accompanied by abnormalities of the hand on the same side.

Polar

Relating to a pole or direction, or describing a molecule with slightly different electrical charges at its ends. In biology and chemistry, polarity affects how substances dissolve, move across cell membranes, and interact with other molecules.

Polarity

The arrangement or direction of positive and negative electrical, chemical, or biological properties. Cell polarity helps organize tissue structure and directs processes such as movement, division, absorption, and secretion.

Polarography

Polarography is an electrochemical analytical method that measures current while voltage changes at an electrode to identify or quantify reducible substances.

Pol Gene

The HIV gene encoding enzymes required for viral replication, including protease, reverse transcriptase, and integrase; antiretroviral drugs target these products.

Polidocanol

Polidocanol is a detergent sclerosant injected to close selected varicose veins or vascular lesions by damaging the vessel lining and promoting fibrosis.

Polio

An infection caused by poliovirus, also called poliomyelitis. It spreads mainly when virus from an infected person's stool enters the mouth, and it can also spread through respiratory secretions. Most infected people have no symptoms or have a short, mild illness with fever, sore throat, tiredness, nausea, headache, or stomach pain. Fewer than 1% of infections cause the virus to affect the brain or spinal cord, leading to meningitis, muscle weakness, or acute flaccid paralysis, which is often uneven between the limbs and may become permanent. Paralysis of the muscles used for breathing can be fatal. Vaccination prevents polio.

Alternate Names:
Poliomyelitis

Poliomyelitis

Alternate name; see *Polio*.

Poliosis

A localized patch of white or depigmented hair caused by reduced melanin in follicles, occurring in vitiligo, alopecia areata, inflammatory disease, genetic syndromes, or after injury.

Poliovirus

An enterovirus that causes poliomyelitis. It is transmitted mainly by the fecal-oral route; most infections are asymptomatic, but a small proportion cause meningitis or acute flaccid paralysis by damaging motor neurons in the spinal cord. Diagnosis uses molecular testing, usually reverse-transcription PCR of stool or other appropriate specimens.

Pollakisuria

Pollakisuria is unusually frequent urination, often in small amounts, caused by irritation, infection, stones, bladder disorders, anxiety, or other urinary conditions.

Pollakiuria

Frequent urination, often in small amounts. It may occur with urinary infection, irritation, diabetes, pregnancy, medicines, or anxiety; in some children it is a temporary benign pattern, while pain, fever, blood, thirst, or weight loss may indicate an underlying disorder.

Pollen

Tiny plant grains released for reproduction that can trigger allergies, asthma symptoms, or eye inflammation.

Pollen-Food Allergy Syndrome

An allergic reaction to certain raw fruits, vegetables, or nuts in people sensitized to related pollen proteins. It usually causes itching or tingling of the mouth and throat and is also called oral allergy syndrome.

Pollex

The anatomical term for the thumb, the first and most mobile digit of the hand. It has two bones and can touch the fingertips, allowing precise grasping; injury or arthritis can cause pain and loss of hand function.

Pollution

Contamination of air, water, soil, or surroundings by substances that may harm health or ecosystems.

Poly A

A sequence of adenine nucleotides added to the end of many messenger RNA molecules, helping regulate stability, transport, and translation.

Polyadenylation

Addition of a polyadenosine tail to the 3′ end of many eukaryotic messenger RNAs, promoting stability, nuclear export, and efficient translation.

Polyamine

A small positively charged molecule, such as putrescine, spermidine, or spermine, required for cell growth and nucleic-acid function.

Polyamine Catabolism

The enzyme-controlled breakdown of polyamines, natural substances involved in cell growth and function. This process produces chemicals that can affect cell signals, oxidative stress, inflammation, development, and cancer biology.

Polyangiitis

Inflammation affecting multiple blood vessels. The term appears in the names of several vasculitis diseases, including microscopic polyangiitis and granulomatosis with polyangiitis; by itself, it does not identify one specific disease.

Polyarteritis

Inflammation of several arteries, which can reduce blood flow and damage organs. Causes and effects vary; polyarteritis nodosa is a rare form that mainly affects medium-sized arteries and may cause fever, muscle pain, skin changes, nerve problems, or abdominal pain.

Polyarteritis Nodosa

A systemic necrotizing vasculitis of medium-sized muscular arteries that can narrow or weaken vessels and impair blood flow. It may affect the skin, peripheral nerves, kidneys, muscles, or gastrointestinal tract; pulmonary arteries are usually spared.

Alternate Names:
PAN; Kussmaul-Maier Disease

Polyarthritis

Inflammation involving multiple joints, commonly defined as five or more. It is a clinical pattern rather than a single diagnosis and may result from autoimmune, infectious, crystal-related, or other inflammatory disorders.

Polyarticular Joint Pain

Pain affecting multiple joints, caused by systemic in-

flammatory disease, infection, osteoarthritis, crystal disease, medication, or other conditions. The pattern, duration, swelling, and associated symptoms guide evaluation.

Polybrominated Biphenyl

A group of brominated industrial chemicals that can persist in the environment and cause toxic effects after exposure.

Polychlorinated Biphenyl

A group of persistent industrial chemicals that can accumulate in body fat and are associated with cancer, endocrine, immune, and neurologic effects.

Polychondritis

A relapsing immune-related disease that inflames and damages cartilage. It may affect the ears, nose, joints, voice box, windpipe, or inner ear, causing pain, deformity, breathing problems, hearing loss, or balance symptoms.

Polychromasia

The presence of unusually bluish, immature red blood cells on a blood smear. It usually means bone marrow is releasing cells quickly, often because of blood loss, red-cell destruction, or treatment response.

Polychromatophilia

Polychromatophilia is bluish-gray staining of red blood cells on a blood smear, reflecting increased circulating immature reticulocytes from stimulated red-cell production.

Polycystic Kidney Disease

An inherited disorder in which many fluid-filled cysts grow in the kidneys, which may enlarge and gradually lose function. The main forms are autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease, usually recognized in adulthood, and autosomal recessive polycystic kidney disease, which can affect infants or children. Complications may include high blood pressure, pain, blood in the urine, kidney failure, or cysts in the liver.

Alternate Names:
PKD

Polycystic Liver Disease

An inherited condition in which many fluid-filled cysts develop in the liver. The cysts may enlarge the liver and cause abdominal fullness or pain; liver function is often preserved, but kidney cysts may also occur.

Polycystic Ovarian Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

Polycystic Ovary

Polycystic ovaries contain many small follicles and may occur as a normal variant or with polycystic ovary syndrome. PCOS additionally involves ovulatory dysfunction, androgen excess, irregular periods, infertility, acne, or metabolic risk and requires clinical—not ultrasound alone—diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Polycystic Ovarian Morphology; PCOM

Polycystic Ovary Syndrome

A common hormonal and metabolic disorder that can disrupt ovulation and increase androgen levels or effects. It may cause irregular or absent periods, acne, extra facial or body hair, scalp hair thinning, or difficulty becoming pregnant. Some people have many small ovarian follicles, but these are not required. In adults, diagnosis generally requires two of three features: ovulation problems, androgen excess, or polycystic-appearing ovaries, which may be assessed by ultrasound or an anti-Müllerian hormone test. Other causes are excluded first. In adolescents, persistent menstrual irregularity and androgen excess are both needed; ultrasound appearance alone does not establish the diagnosis. Insulin resistance and increased risk of type 2 diabetes may also occur.

Alternate Names:
PCOS; Polycystic Ovarian Syndrome; Stein-Leventhal Syndrome

Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS)

Alternate name; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

Polycythaemia

An increased red-cell mass or concentration, which may be primary or secondary to another condition.

Polycythemia

Too many red blood cells in the blood. It can be caused by a bone-marrow problem, low oxygen, smoking, dehydration, some medicines, or another illness. In some cases, it raises the risk of blood clots.

Polycythemia Vera

A long-term bone-marrow cancer that produces too many red blood cells and sometimes too many white cells and platelets. The thicker blood can cause headaches, itching, clots, bleeding, or an enlarged spleen.

Alternate Names:
Primary Polycythemia; Polycythaemia Vera

Polydactyly

A birth condition in which a person has one or more extra fingers or toes. The extra digit may be on the thumb or big-toe side, the little-finger or little-toe side, or between the usual digits. It may occur alone or as part of a genetic syndrome. Treatment depends on its size and function and may involve reconstructive surgery.

Polydipsia

Excessive thirst that leads to drinking unusually large amounts of fluid. Common causes include uncontrolled diabetes, water-balance disorders, medicines, and some mental health conditions.

Polyene

A molecule containing multiple carbon-carbon double bonds; polyene medicines such as amphotericin B act against fungal cell membranes.

Polyethylene

A plastic polymer used in packaging and medical devices; implanted polyethylene components may wear over time and produce foreign-body reactions.

Polyethylene Glycol

A polymer used in medicines, especially laxatives that draw water into stool to ease constipation.

Polygenic

Influenced by variants in many genes, often together with environmental factors. Height, blood pressure, and risk for many common diseases are polygenic traits.

Polygenic Disease

A disease influenced by small effects from many genes together with environment and lifestyle. Examples include common diabetes, high blood pressure, heart disease, and some cancers; risk is inherited, not certainty.

Polygenic Hypercholesterolemia

Elevated low-density lipoprotein cholesterol caused by the combined effect of multiple genetic variants and environmental factors rather than one dominant pathogenic variant. Levels and cardiovascular risk vary; other contributing causes may coexist.

Polygenic Inheritance

Inheritance in which many genes, each with a small effect, together influence a trait or disease risk. Height, skin color, blood pressure, diabetes risk, and heart-disease risk are examples; environment also contributes.

Polygenic Obesity

Obesity influenced by many small genetic differences together with eating patterns, activity, sleep, medicines, and the surrounding environment.

Polygenic Risk Score

An estimate of a person's inherited tendency toward a disease, calculated from many small genetic differences. It changes estimated risk but does not predict certainty; family history, environment, and other health factors also influence risk.

Polyglandular Autoimmune Syndrome

An autoimmune disorder in which two or more en-

docrine glands are damaged, causing combinations of thyroid, adrenal, parathyroid, pancreatic, or gonadal dysfunction.

Polyglandular Autoimmune Syndrome Type 1

An inherited autoimmune syndrome, usually beginning in childhood, involving chronic mucocutaneous candidiasis and autoimmune damage to the parathyroid and adrenal glands. Other organs may be affected, and the exact combination varies.

Polyglandular Autoimmune Syndrome Type 2

An autoimmune syndrome, usually beginning in adulthood, characterized by autoimmune adrenal insufficiency together with autoimmune thyroid disease and/or type 1 diabetes. Other autoimmune disorders may coexist.

Polygraphy

Polygraphy is the simultaneous recording of several physiologic signals, such as breathing, heart rate, oxygen level, and movement, often during sleep testing.

Polyhydramnios

An unusually large amount of amniotic fluid during pregnancy. It may cause abdominal discomfort, breathlessness, or swelling and can increase the risks of early birth, abnormal fetal position, cord problems, or heavy bleeding after delivery.

Polyketide Synthase

An enzyme system that builds complex natural products from repeated carbon units, producing many antibiotics, toxins, and other biologically active molecules.

Polymastia

The presence of extra breast tissue, sometimes with an additional nipple, along the embryonic milk line. Accessory breast tissue can enlarge or develop the same benign or malignant conditions as normal breast tissue.

Polymenorrhea

Menstrual periods that occur unusually often, commonly at intervals shorter than about 21 days. Causes include hormonal changes, thyroid disease, fibroids, bleeding disorders, medicines, and the menopausal transition; persistent frequent bleeding can reflect an underlying disorder.

Polymenorrhoea

British spelling of polymenorrhea: menstrual periods occurring unusually often, commonly at intervals shorter than about 21 days.

Polymer

A large molecule made of repeating smaller units called monomers; polymers are widely used in biology, medicines, and medical materials.

Polymerase Chain Reaction

A laboratory method that makes millions of copies of a selected piece of DNA so it can be detected and studied. It is used to identify infections, inherited conditions, cancer-related gene changes, and other genetic material. The target and interpretation depend on the diagnostic question.

Polymerase Chain Reaction Test

A molecular diagnostic test that amplifies specific nucleic acid (DNA or RNA) sequences to detect pathogens or genetic variants; see *Polymerase Chain Reaction*.

Polymerization

Chemical joining of many small monomers into a larger polymer, a process important in biomolecules, plastics, dental materials, drug delivery, and laboratory techniques.

Polymicrobial Infections

Infections caused by two or more kinds of germs at the same time. They commonly affect contaminated wounds, the abdomen, or the lungs and may require treatment directed at several different organisms.

Polymicrogyria

A brain-development abnormality in which the outer brain surface has too many small, unusually formed folds. It may cause seizures, developmental delay, movement problems, or learning difficulties, depending on the areas involved.

Polymorphic

Having more than one form or appearance. The term may describe a rash, crystal, cell, gene variant, heart rhythm, or tumor. Its medical importance depends on the structure being described and the other clinical findings.

Polymorphic Eruption of Pregnancy

An itchy inflammatory eruption of pregnancy, usually beginning in abdominal stretch marks late in pregnancy and spreading to the trunk or limbs while sparing the umbilicus. It is uncomfortable but generally does not harm the fetus and usually resolves after delivery.

Polymorphic Light Eruption

Alternate name; see *Polymorphous Light Eruption*.

Polymorphism

The presence of two or more inherited genetic forms or visible traits within a population.

Polymorphonuclear

Having a segmented or multilobed nucleus. The term commonly describes certain white blood cells, especially neutrophils, eosinophils, and basophils.

Polymorphonuclear Leukocyte

A white blood cell with a multilobed nucleus, especially a neutrophil, eosinophil, or basophil, involved in innate immune defense and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
PMN

Polymorphous

Having lesions or clinical features that differ in shape, size, or stage and therefore show multiple forms.

Polymorphous Light Eruption

An acquired, often seasonal photodermatosis causing an itchy eruption of papules or plaques, sometimes vesicles, several hours to days after ultraviolet exposure. It often recurs in spring or early summer and may lessen as the skin acclimatizes to sunlight.

Alternate Names:
PMLE; Sun Poisoning

Polymyalgia Rheumatica

An inflammatory rheumatic disease that causes pain and stiffness around the shoulders and hips, often also the neck and upper arms, mainly in adults aged 50 or older. Stiffness is usually worse in the morning or after rest; muscle strength is generally preserved. It is closely associated with giant cell arteritis.

Alternate Names:
PMR

Polymyositis

An uncommon immune-related disease causing gradual, usually symmetrical weakness in muscles close to the body, especially the shoulders, hips, and thighs. It can make climbing stairs, lifting, or swallowing difficult and may raise muscle-enzyme levels.

Alternate Names:
PM; Idiopathic Inflammatory Myopathy

Polymyxin

A group of antibiotics that disrupt bacterial cell membranes, used mainly for selected gram-negative infections.

Polymyxin B

An antibiotic active against selected gram-negative bacteria; kidney and nerve toxicity limit its use to difficult infections.

Polyneuritis

Inflammation or injury affecting multiple peripheral nerves, causing symmetric pain, numbness, weakness, or autonomic dysfunction; causes include immune disease, infection, toxins, and deficiency.

Polyneuropathy

A generalized disorder affecting multiple peripheral nerves, often causing symmetric numbness, tingling, burning pain, weakness, or impaired reflexes in the limbs.

Polynucleotide

A chain of linked nucleotides forming DNA, RNA, or a related laboratory molecule. Its sequence stores or carries genetic information and determines how cells make proteins or regulate biological processes.

Polyoma Virus

A polyomavirus; some human polyomaviruses are widespread and cause serious disease mainly in immunocompromised people.

Polyomavirus Hominis 2

A human polyomavirus designation associated with a virus found in people; clinically important disease is uncommon and mainly associated with immune suppression.

Polyp

A growth projecting from a mucous membrane; it may be benign, precancerous, or rarely cancerous.

Polyp Biopsy

A polyp biopsy removes part or all of a polyp for microscopic examination to determine whether it is benign, precancerous, or cancerous.

Polypectomy

The surgical or endoscopic excision and removal of a polyp from a mucous membrane surface, most commonly during colonoscopy; see *Polyp* and *Polyp Biopsy*.

Polypeptide

A chain of amino acids joined by peptide bonds. One or more folded polypeptide chains make up many proteins.

Polyphagia

Unusually strong or persistent hunger that may lead to eating much more than usual. Causes include poorly controlled diabetes, an overactive thyroid, certain medicines, inherited conditions, and some mental-health disorders.

Polypharmacology

The study or use of a medicine that affects several targets in the body. This can be helpful when one disease involves multiple pathways, but it may also increase side effects and medicine interactions.

Polypharmacy

Use of several medicines at the same time, often five or more. Some combinations are necessary, but taking many medicines increases the risk of interactions, side effects, confusion, missed doses, and prescribing errors, especially in older adults.

Polyposis

A condition in which many polyps develop, especially in the bowel or other digestive organs. Polyposis may be inherited or acquired, and some types increase the risk of colorectal or other cancers.

Polypropylene

A synthetic plastic polymer used in medical supplies, sutures, meshes, and containers; implanted materials may rarely cause infection or foreign-body reactions.

Polyp Surveillance Colonoscopy

A follow-up colon examination after polyps have been found or removed. The timing depends on the number, size, type, and microscopic features of the polyps and on the person's overall risk.

Polyradiculitis

Inflammation or other disease affecting several spinal nerve roots. It may cause weakness, numbness, pain, and reduced reflexes; causes include infections, autoimmune disorders, and toxins.

Polyradiculopathy

Disease affecting multiple spinal nerve roots, producing pain, weakness, sensory loss, or reflex changes

in a distribution determined by the involved roots.

Polysaccharide

A carbohydrate made of many linked simple sugar units. Examples include starch, glycogen, cellulose, and some bacterial capsules.

Polysome

A group of ribosomes attached to one messenger RNA molecule at the same time. Together they make many copies of the protein instructions, helping cells produce proteins efficiently.

Polysomnography

An overnight sleep study that records brain activity, eye movements, muscle activity, heart rhythm, airflow, breathing effort, and blood oxygen. It helps identify sleep-related breathing problems, unusual movements, seizures, and other sleep disorders.

Polysplenia

A congenital condition with multiple small spleens and variable abnormalities of organ arrangement, heart, blood vessels, or intestinal rotation.

Polystyrene

A synthetic plastic polymer used in containers and laboratory materials; burning it can release hazardous fumes.

Polytene Chromosome

An enlarged chromosome formed by repeated DNA replication without cell division, displaying visible bands and commonly used to study gene activity in insect tissues.

Polythelia

The presence of one or more additional nipples, usually along the embryonic milk line. It is often harmless, although accessory tissue can rarely have the same disorders as normal breast tissue.

Polythiazide

A thiazide diuretic formerly used to treat high blood pressure and fluid retention by increasing renal salt and water excretion.

Polytrauma

Serious injuries affecting two or more body regions or organ systems, usually caused by a major accident, fall, blast, or violence. The injuries may include bleeding, fractures, brain injury, chest injury, or damage to internal organs.

Polyunsaturated Fat

A type of fat usually liquid at room temperature, found in fish, vegetable oils, nuts, and seeds. Some are essential because the body cannot make them.

Polyurethane

A family of synthetic polymers used in medical tubing, implants, dressings, and other products; tissue response depends on formulation and site.

Polyuria

Producing unusually large amounts of urine, commonly more than about three liters daily in an adult. Causes include diabetes, excess fluids, medicines, kidney problems, hormone disorders, and some inherited conditions.

Polyvalent

Effective against or involving multiple types, strains, antigens, or targets.

Polyvinyl

A family of polymers used in plastics and medical materials; properties vary according to attached chemical groups.

Pomalidomide

An immunomodulatory medicine used with other treatments for selected multiple myeloma and related blood cancers; it can cause severe birth defects and blood abnormalities.

Pompe Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which a missing enzyme causes stored sugar to build up inside muscle cells. Babies may develop severe weakness, an enlarged

heart, and breathing or feeding problems; later-onset disease mainly weakens the limbs and breathing muscles. Enzyme replacement and supportive care can slow or improve the disease.

Alternate Names:
Glycogen Storage Disease Type II; Acid Maltase Deficiency; GSD II

Pompholyx

Alternate name; see *Dyshidrotic Eczema*.

Pompholyx Eczema

Alternate name; see *Dyshidrotic Eczema*.

Pons

The middle part of the brainstem, containing pathways and nuclei involved in movement, sensation, breathing, and cranial-nerve function.

Pontiac Fever

A mild, self-limited flu-like illness caused by Legionella bacteria without the pneumonia typical of Legionnaires' disease.

Pontine

Relating to the pons, a part of the brainstem between the midbrain and medulla. The pons helps carry movement and feeling signals and contains centers involved in eye movement, facial movement, hearing, balance, and breathing. A stroke or bleed there can cause weakness, loss of sensation, trouble speaking or swallowing, coma, or a locked-in state. Rapid correction of very low sodium can also damage it.

Pontine Myelinolysis

A severe non-inflammatory demyelinating neurological disorder of the central pons caused by rapid, overly aggressive intravenous correction of chronic hyponatremia, presenting with spastic quadriparesis, pseudobulbar palsy, dysarthria, dysphagia, and the "locked-in" syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Central Pontine Myelinolysis; Osmotic Demyelination Syndrome; ODS

Poor Circulation

Reduced or abnormal blood flow, usually referring to arterial insufficiency or venous disease, causing coolness, color change, pain, swelling, ulcers, or delayed wound healing.

Poor Color Vision

Alternate name; see *Color Blindness*.

Popcorn Lung Bronchiolitis Obliterans

Bronchiolitis obliterans is irreversible scarring and narrowing of small airways that can follow toxic inhalation, infection, transplantation, or autoimmune disease. It causes persistent cough and breathlessness with obstructive lung testing; exposure avoidance and specialist care are important.

Popliteal

Relating to the hollow behind the knee. This area contains the popliteal artery, vein, and nerves and can be affected by an artery aneurysm, a blood clot, or a Baker cyst.

Popliteal Aneurysm

A weakened, bulging section of the artery behind the knee. It may form blood clots, block blood flow, or send clots into the lower leg, causing pain, coldness, numbness, or tissue damage. Larger aneurysms may need repair.

Popliteal Artery

The main artery behind the knee. It continues from the thigh artery and divides into arteries supplying the lower leg and foot; blockage or injury can cause pain, coldness, numbness, or loss of circulation.

Popliteal Artery Aneurysm

An abnormal enlargement of the artery behind the knee that may cause limb ischemia, clotting, or embolization.

Popliteal Artery Entrapment Syndrome

An uncommon vascular cause of exertional lower extremity claudication in young, athletic individuals without cardiovascular risk factors, resulting from

an anomalous anatomical relationship between the popliteal artery and the medial head of the gastrocnemius muscle that compresses the artery during plantarflexion.

Popliteal Cyst

A fluid-filled swelling behind the knee, also called a Baker cyst, caused by communication between the joint and a bursa and often associated with arthritis, meniscal injury, or inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Baker Cyst

Popliteal Fossa

Diamond-shaped space behind the knee, bounded superolaterally by the biceps femoris, superomedially by the semimembranosus and semitendinosus, and inferiorly by the two heads of the gastrocnemius. It contains the popliteal artery and vein, tibial nerve, and common fibular nerve; the popliteal pulse is palpated with the knee slightly flexed.

Popliteal Vein

A deep vein behind the knee formed by the union of the anterior and posterior tibial veins. It continues as the femoral vein and can be affected by deep-vein thrombosis.

Population Attributable Fraction

The estimated proportion of disease in a whole population that could be prevented if a specific harmful exposure were removed, assuming the exposure truly causes the disease and other conditions stayed the same.

Population Attributable Risk

The estimated amount of disease in a population linked to a specific exposure. It helps show the potential public-health benefit of reducing that exposure, but it depends on accurate data and a causal relationship.

Population Genetics

The study of how gene frequencies and genetic variation change within and between populations through inheritance, mutation, selection, migration, and genetic drift.

Population Group

A defined set of people sharing a characteristic such as age, location, exposure, ancestry, occupation, or health condition for epidemiologic or clinical analysis.

Porcelain Gallbladder

Hard calcium deposits in the wall of the gallbladder, usually after long-standing inflammation or gallstones. It may cause no symptoms but can be associated with gallbladder disease; imaging findings guide discussion of monitoring or removal.

Porcelain Inlay

A tooth-colored ceramic restoration bonded into a prepared cavity within a tooth. It can repair selected areas of decay or damage while preserving more tooth structure than a full crown.

Porcine

Porcine means derived from or relating to pigs; porcine tissues, enzymes, and biologic products may be used in medicine after appropriate processing and screening.

Pore

A pore is a small opening or channel in a surface, membrane, tissue, or material that permits passage of fluid, gas, particles, or cellular contents.

Porencephaly

A fluid-filled cavity within the brain caused by abnormal development or damage before or after birth. Effects vary with its size and location and may include seizures, weakness, movement problems, or developmental delay.

Porfimer Sodium

A photosensitizing medicine used with light therapy to destroy selected abnormal tissues, including some tumors; it causes prolonged light sensitivity.

Porin

A porin is a channel-forming protein in an outer membrane, especially of Gram-negative bacteria, allowing passage of selected small molecules.

Pork Tapeworm

A parasite acquired by eating undercooked pork; its larvae can invade tissues and cause cysticercosis.

Porokeratosis

A group of skin conditions that cause one or more ring-shaped, scaly patches with a raised border. Some forms can rarely develop into skin cancer, particularly long-standing or changing lesions.

Poroma

A usually noncancerous tumor arising from a sweat gland. It often appears as a flesh-colored, pink, or red lump on the palms, soles, or other skin and may be removed if painful, bleeding, or uncertain in diagnosis.

Porphyria

A group of rare metabolic disorders caused by a deficiency in one of the specific enzymes needed to produce heme, a vital component of hemoglobin that carries oxygen in blood. When an enzyme is faulty, chemical building blocks called porphyrins build up to toxic levels in the body. Depending on the specific type, porphyria can cause severe episodes of abdominal pain, nerve dysfunction, and psychological symptoms (acute porphyrias), or severe skin sensitivity and blistering upon sun exposure (cutaneous porphyrias).

Alternate Names:
Porphyrias

Porphyria Cutanea Tarda

The most common porphyria, caused by reduced activity of hepatic uroporphyrinogen decarboxylase (UROD), leading to accumulation of porphyrins in the liver and skin. It causes fragile, blistering skin on sun-exposed areas. Associated factors include hepatitis C, excess iron, alcohol use, estrogen exposure, and certain genetic UROD variants.

Porphyrias

Plural form; see *Porphyria*.

Porphyrin

A ring-shaped compound involved in heme and other biological molecules; abnormal accumulation occurs in porphyrias.

Porphyrins Blood Test

A blood porphyrin test measures porphyrins or related compounds and helps evaluate suspected porphyria and disorders of haem production.

Porphyrins Urine Test

A urine porphyrin test measures porphyrins or their precursors and helps investigate suspected porphyria or abnormal haem metabolism.

Porphyromonas

A genus of anaerobic gram-negative bacteria found especially in the mouth and associated with periodontal and other infections.

Porphyromonas Bennonis

An anaerobic oral bacterium rarely isolated from human specimens and occasionally associated with mixed infection.

Porphyromonas Catoniae

An anaerobic gram-negative bacterium found in the mouth and occasionally associated with periodontal or mixed infection.

Porphyromonas Endodontalis

A mouth bacterium that grows without oxygen and is associated with infected tooth pulp and root canals. It may contribute to dental infection, but diagnosis depends on symptoms, examination, imaging, and laboratory findings.

Porphyromonas Levii

A Porphyromonas species found mainly in animals and rarely associated with human infection. An animal-associated bacterium rarely linked to human infection, usually in wounds or other opportunistic

settings.

Porphyromonas Somerae

A bacterium that grows without oxygen and is occasionally found in human wounds, abscesses, or other samples. When it causes infection, treatment depends on laboratory identification, infection location, and antibiotic susceptibility.

Portacaval Shunting

A surgical or image-guided connection that diverts blood around the liver to lower dangerously high pressure in the portal veins. It may reduce bleeding risk but can worsen confusion caused by liver disease.

Portal Circulation

The flow of blood from the digestive organs and spleen through the portal vein to the liver before it returns to the general circulation.

Portal Hypertension

Abnormally high pressure in the veins carrying blood from the digestive organs to the liver, most often because of cirrhosis. It can enlarge veins in the esophagus or stomach, cause abdominal fluid buildup, enlarge the spleen, or lead to bleeding.

Alternate Names:
PHT

Portal Hypertensive Colopathy

Changes in the colon caused by high pressure in veins around the liver, usually from advanced liver disease. Enlarged fragile blood vessels may cause visible or hidden bleeding and anemia.

Portal Hypertensive Gastropathy

Changes in the stomach lining caused by high pressure in the veins around the liver. The lining may look mottled and bleed slowly or suddenly, causing anemia or vomiting of blood in severe cases.

Portal System

A network of veins that carries blood from the stomach, intestines, spleen, pancreas, and gallbladder to the liver. The liver processes nutrients and many absorbed substances before the blood returns to the general circulation.

Portal Vein

The large vein that carries blood from the digestive organs, spleen, pancreas, and gallbladder to the liver. A clot or increased pressure in this vein can cause enlarged abdominal veins, bleeding, or fluid buildup.

Portal Vein Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of blood flow through the portal vein or its branches, caused by thrombosis, tumor, compression, inflammation, or scarring. It may produce portal hypertension, enlarged veins, abdominal fluid, intestinal injury, or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Portal Vein Thrombosis

A blood clot that partly or completely blocks the portal vein or one of its branches. It may occur with cirrhosis, cancer, abdominal infection or inflammation, surgery, or a clotting disorder. It can cause portal hypertension, enlarged veins, spleen enlargement, intestinal injury, or gastrointestinal bleeding.

Portion Of Cytosol

A region of the cell's aqueous internal fluid outside membrane-bound organelles, containing ions, metabolites, proteins, and enzymes that support cellular reactions.

Portion Size

The amount of food or drink served or eaten at one time, distinct from a standardized serving size and important for estimating energy, carbohydrate, sodium, and nutrient intake.

Portopulmonary Syndrome

High blood pressure in the arteries of the lungs occurring with portal hypertension or serious liver disease. It can cause breathlessness, tiredness, chest discomfort, or fainting and affects decisions about liver treatment or transplantation.

Port-Wine Stain

A permanent birthmark caused by widened small blood vessels, appearing as flat pink, red, or purple skin.

Position

The location or arrangement of a body part, organ, fetus, or patient. Position can affect examination findings, movement, comfort, circulation, breathing, childbirth, medical procedures, and interpretation of imaging.

Positional Asphyxia

Fatal or potentially fatal impairment of breathing caused by body position that restricts chest movement, airway patency, or venous return. Risk is increased by restraint, intoxication, obesity, and inability to reposition; findings are nonspecific and require scene and medical correlation.

Positive

Positive means that a test, finding, result, or response is present or above a defined threshold; interpretation depends on the test and clinical setting.

Positive Airway Pressure Treatment

Treatment that uses pressurized air delivered through a mask or similar device to keep the airway open during sleep or breathing difficulty. It is commonly used for obstructive sleep apnea; mask discomfort, dry airways, leaks, or skin irritation may occur.

Positive End-Expiratory Pressure

Pressure kept in the airways at the end of breathing out, usually by a ventilator. It helps keep the lung's air sacs open and improve oxygen levels, but excessive pressure can injure the lungs or lower blood pressure.

Positive Feedback

A body-control process in which a response strengthens the original change, making the process grow until a specific event is completed. Examples include contractions during labor and blood clotting.

Positive Finding

A positive finding is an observed symptom, examination sign, image, laboratory result, or test response that supports the presence of a specified condition or feature.

Positive Predictive Value

The chance that a person with a positive test result truly has the condition being tested for. It depends on test accuracy and how common the condition is among the people tested.

Positive Predictive Value In Surveillance

The proportion of reported signals or alerts that represent true events meeting the surveillance case definition. It is influenced by the specificity of the signal and the underlying prevalence of the condition.

Positive Pressure Ventilation

Breathing support that pushes air or oxygen into the lungs under pressure. It may be delivered through a mask or a breathing tube and can support or replace a person's own breathing during respiratory failure.

Positive Psychology

The study of wellbeing, strengths, resilience, relationships, and factors that help people function and thrive. Its practices may support coping and quality of life but do not replace treatment for illness.

Positive-Strand RNA Virus

A virus whose RNA can be read directly by an infected cell as instructions for making viral proteins. This allows the virus to begin producing new parts soon after entering the cell.

Positive Symptoms

Symptoms reflecting an excess or distortion of normal mental functions, such as hallucinations, delusions, disorganized speech, or grossly disorganized behavior. They are contrasted with negative symptoms, which reflect loss or reduction of function.

Positron

A particle with the same mass as an electron but a positive charge. Some medical tracers release positrons; when one meets an electron, energy is produced and detected during a PET scan.

Positron Camera

A positron camera detects paired gamma rays from positron annihilation and is used in positron-emission tomography to map tracer distribution.

Positron Emission Mammography

PET imaging of breast. Higher sensitivity than mammography for dense breasts. Limited availability. A breast imaging test combining positron emission scanning with mammography to show tissue activity and structure.

Positron Emission Tomography

An imaging test that uses a small amount of radioactive tracer to show tissue activity, such as glucose use, blood flow, or specific proteins. It is often combined with CT or MRI to locate abnormal areas more precisely.

Positron Emission Tomography Scan

A nuclear medicine imaging scan that utilizes positron-emitting radiotracers (such as FDG) to assess metabolic activity in tissues, widely used in oncology and neurology; see *Positron Emission Tomography*.

Post-Acute Rehabilitation

Time-limited interdisciplinary care after an acute illness, injury, or hospitalization to restore mobility, self-care, cognition, communication, and safe community function. Intensity and setting depend on medical stability and rehabilitation potential.

Post-Adoptive Depression

Depression that begins after adopting a child. Stress, sleep loss, adjustment demands, past trauma, or unmet expectations may contribute; symptoms include persistent sadness, loss of interest, or thoughts of self-harm.

Postanesthesia Care Unit

The postanesthesia care unit is a monitored recovery area where patients are observed during the immediate postoperative period. Admission assessment includes vital signs, level of consciousness, pain assessment, and surgical site evaluation.

Post-Cardiac Arrest Management

Care after return of spontaneous circulation that supports breathing and circulation, identifies and treats the cause of the arrest, manages temperature and seizures when indicated, and assesses neurologic recovery over time.

Post-Cardiac Injury Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Dressler Syndrome*.

Post-Chemotherapy Cognitive Impairment

Alternate name; see *Chemo Brain*.

Postcholecystectomy Syndrome

Persistence or recurrence of symptoms after cholecystectomy. Causes include retained common bile duct stones, sphincter of Oddi dysfunction, bile salt malabsorption, irritable bowel syndrome, and other gastrointestinal conditions. Evaluation includes liver function tests, MRCP, and endoscopic ultrasound.

Post Cibum

A medication instruction meaning “after meals,” abbreviated P.C. The abbreviation can have other meanings in medical records.

Alternate Names:
PC; After Meals

Postcoital Bleeding

Bleeding from the vagina after sexual intercourse. Causes include infection, dryness, injury, polyps, pregnancy-related conditions, or cancer.

Alternate Names:
Contact Bleeding; Postcoital Vaginal Bleeding

Postcoital Test

A fertility test that examines cervical mucus after intercourse for sperm presence and movement. It is rarely used now because results are variable and better-established fertility evaluations are available.

Post-Concussional Syndrome

Persistent physical, cognitive, emotional, or sleep symptoms after a concussion or mild traumatic brain injury.

Post-Concussion Syndrome

Ongoing symptoms after a concussion, such as headache, dizziness, tiredness, poor concentration, sleep problems, or mood changes. Symptoms usually improve gradually; evaluation and a stepwise return to activity help guide recovery.

Post-Dural Puncture Headache

A headache that begins after a spinal tap or accidental puncture during an epidural. It is usually worse when sitting or standing and improves when lying down because spinal fluid has leaked; neck stiffness, nausea, ringing ears, or light sensitivity may occur.

Posterior

Located behind or toward the back of the body or a body structure. The term is used to describe anatomical direction, position, movement, imaging findings, and areas affected by disease or injury.

Posterior Chamber

The eye space between the iris and lens, filled with clear fluid that nourishes tissues and helps maintain pressure.

Posterior Cord Syndrome

An incomplete spinal cord injury syndrome resulting from selective damage to the posterior columns (fasciculus gracilis and cuneatus), caused by posterior spinal artery infarction, tabes dorsalis, or subacute combined degeneration, characterized by loss of proprioception, vibration sense, and two-point discrimination below the lesion with preserved motor strength and pain/temperature sensation.

Alternate Names:
Dorsal Column Syndrome; Posterior Column Myelopathy

Posterior Cruciate

Usually referring to the posterior cruciate ligament, a strong knee ligament that limits backward movement of the shinbone. Injury can cause pain, swelling, and knee instability.

Posterior Cruciate Ligament Injury

A stretch or tear of the ligament deep inside the knee that prevents the shinbone from moving too far backward. It may follow a blow to the shin, a fall on a bent knee, or severe twisting and can cause pain, swelling, and instability.

Posterior Cruciate Ligament Tear

A partial or complete tear of the strong ligament deep inside the knee that limits backward movement of the shinbone. It often follows a forceful blow to the shin or a fall on a bent knee and may cause pain, swelling, and knee instability. Treatment depends on severity and other injuries.

Posterior Descending Artery

A heart artery that runs along the back groove between the lower chambers and supplies part of the back and lower heart muscle. It usually branches from the right coronary artery but may arise from another heart artery.

Posterior Drawer Test

A knee examination in which the lower leg is gently pushed backward while the knee is bent. Excessive backward movement may indicate injury to the ligament that stabilizes the back of the knee.

Posterior Epistaxis

Nasal hemorrhage originating from arteries situated in the posterior nasal cavity or nasopharynx (most commonly branches of the sphenopalatine artery or Woodruff plexus), typically severe, profuse, draining down the oropharynx, and requiring posterior nasal packing or arterial embolization.

Posterior Fossa Tumor

A growth in the lower back part of the skull, where the cerebellum and brainstem are located. It may cause headache, vomiting, unsteady movement, eye problems, or changes in breathing by pressing on nearby tissue or blocking brain fluid.

Posterior Heel Bursitis

Inflammation of a bursa near the back of the heel, causing pain and swelling.

Alternate Names:
Retrocalcaneal Bursitis; Achilles Bursitis

Posterior Keyhole Foraminotomy

An operation through a small opening in the back that enlarges the passage where a spinal nerve leaves the spine. It relieves pressure from causes such as a disk bulge or arthritis and may reduce radiating pain or weakness.

Posterior Mediastinum

The back part of the lower mediastinum, in front of the thoracic spine. It contains the esophagus, descending aorta, azygos veins, thoracic duct, and nerves.

Posterior Myocardial Infarction

A heart attack affecting the back wall of the heart, usually because a coronary artery is blocked. It may be missed on a standard ECG, so additional ECG leads or imaging may be needed when symptoms suggest it.

Posterior Pituitary

The back part of the pituitary gland, which stores and releases hormones made in the brain. Vasopressin helps control body water and blood pressure, while oxytocin supports uterine contractions and release of breast milk.

Posterior Prolapse

Alternate name; see *Rectocele*.

Posterior Reversible Encephalopathy Syndrome

Brain swelling caused by disturbed blood-flow regulation, often linked to very high blood pressure, pregnancy-related hypertension, kidney disease, severe infection, or immune-suppressing medicines. Headache, seizures, confusion, or vision loss may occur; delayed treatment can result in lasting injury.

Posterior Rhinorrhea

Posterior rhinorrhea is mucus draining from the nose into the throat, commonly causing throat clearing or cough from allergy, infection, irritation, or sinus disease.

Posterior Subcapsular Cataract

A cloudy area at the back of the eye's lens, just beneath its outer capsule. Because it often lies in the path of light, it can cause glare, blurred vision, and difficulty reading, especially in bright light.

Posterior Synechiae

Abnormal fibrous adhesions between the posterior surface of the iris and the anterior lens capsule, commonly formed during episodes of acute or chronic iritis and causing an irregular, non-reactive pupil.

Posterior Tibial Artery

A major artery running down the back of the lower leg and behind the inner ankle. It supplies the lower leg and sole of the foot; its pulse is checked when assessing blood flow to the foot.

Posterior Urethral Valves

Abnormal tissue folds present in the urethra of some male babies that block urine leaving the bladder. They can cause a weak urine stream, swollen kidneys, urinary infection, or kidney damage; treatment commonly involves endoscopic valve ablation.

Posterior Uveitis

Inflammation at the back of the eye involving the retina, the layer beneath it, or both. It may cause floaters, blurred or missing vision, or eye pain and can result from infection, immune disease, or another inflammatory condition.

Posterior Vaginal Prolapse

Alternate name; see *Rectocele*.

Posterior Vitreous Detachment

Separation of the jelly inside the eye from the retina, usually as an age-related change. It may cause new flashes or floaters; a retinal tear or detachment can occur at the same time.

Posteroanterior

Posteroanterior means directed from back to front; a PA chest radiograph uses this projection to reduce magnification of the heart.

Post-Exposure Prophylaxis

Medicine or vaccination given after a possible exposure to prevent infection from developing. It is used for selected exposures to HIV, hepatitis B, rabies, and other infections; the regimen and timing depend on the pathogen.

Post-Finasteride Syndrome

A name used for sexual, mood, or cognitive symptoms reported to persist after stopping finasteride. The cause and diagnostic criteria are uncertain, and similar symptoms have other possible causes.

Postganglionic Fiber

An autonomic nerve fiber extending from a ganglion to its target organ after the synapse, carrying sympathetic or parasympathetic signals to smooth muscle, glands, or the heart.

Post-Head Trauma Syndrome

Older term for symptoms that continue after a concussion or mild traumatic brain injury; see *Post-Concussion Syndrome*.

Postherpetic Neuralgia

Persistent nerve pain in an area affected by shingles after the rash has healed.

Alternate Names:
PHN; Shingles-Related Nerve Pain

Posthitis

Inflammation of the foreskin, causing redness, swelling, itching, soreness, discharge, or difficulty retracting it. Causes include infection, irritants, and trapped moisture; it may occur with balanitis. Recurrent episodes can be associated with diabetes or an underlying skin disorder.

Post-Hoc

Performed or analyzed after an event; in statistics, a post-hoc analysis follows the planned primary analysis.

Posthumous

Occurring, discovered, or published after a person's death. A posthumous diagnosis may be based on records, stored samples, or autopsy findings.

Post-Infectious Cough

A chronic cough persisting 3–8 weeks after a URI, caused by transient bronchial hyperresponsiveness and airway inflammation. It is self-limited and usually resolves without treatment. Inhaled corticosteroids, antitussives, and time are the mainstays of management.

Postinflammatory Hyperpigmentation

Darkening of skin after inflammation or injury, caused by increased melanin production or its deposition in the epidermis or dermis.

Post-Intensive Care Syndrome

New or worsened physical, thinking, emotional, or mental-health problems that persist after critical illness or an intensive-care stay. It may include muscle weakness, poor memory or concentration, anxiety, depression, sleep problems, or post-traumatic stress.

Post-Kala-Azar Dermal Leishmaniasis

A skin condition caused by Leishmania donovani that can develop after visceral leishmaniasis (kala-azar), often after apparent recovery. It occurs mainly in South Asia and East Africa and may cause pale or red patches, raised bumps, or nodules. Parasites can remain in the skin and be transmitted by sand flies in areas where the disease occurs.

Alternate Names:
PKDL; Post-Kala-Azar Dermatosis

Postmenopausal

Postmenopausal describes the period after menopause, when ovarian estrogen production and menstrual periods have permanently ceased.

Postmenopausal Bleeding

Vaginal bleeding after menopause. Causes include tissue thinning, polyps, hormone effects, and cancer.

Postmenopausal Osteoporosis

Bone loss caused by lower estrogen levels associated with menopause. Sometimes called type I osteoporosis.

Postmenopause

The stage of life after menopause, when menstrual periods have permanently stopped because the ovaries no longer release eggs regularly and produce much less estrogen.

Post-Micturition Dribbling

Involuntary leakage of urine immediately after a person finishes urinating, usually after leaving the toilet. It is a post-micturition symptom, distinct from terminal dribbling, which is a prolonged, slow trickle at the end of the urinary stream. It may coexist with other lower urinary tract symptoms.

Post-Mortem

Occurring after death or relating to examination of a body afterward. A post-mortem examination can help determine the cause of death, identify disease, and provide information for families or legal investigations.

Postmortem Artifact

A change that happens to a body after death and can look like disease or injury. Causes include decomposition, medical resuscitation, embalming, insects, animals, or movement of blood after death; examiners must distinguish it from changes before death.

Postmortem Changes

Changes that occur after death, including cooling, livor mortis, rigor mortis, drying, autolysis, and putrefaction. Their timing varies with temperature, environment, body condition, and other factors and cannot alone establish an exact time of death.

Postmortem Interval

The estimated time between death and the examination or discovery of a body. Investigators consider body temperature, stiffness, pooling of blood, chemical changes, environment, and insect activity, but the estimate is not exact.

Postmortem Lividity

Purplish-red discoloration of dependent parts of the body after death, caused by blood settling under gravity. Its appearance and timing vary with the environment and other factors, so it cannot establish the time of death by itself.

Alternate Names:
Cadaveric Lividity; Postmortem Suggillation

Postmortem Toxicology

Testing blood, tissues, or other samples after death for medicines, alcohol, poisons, or their breakdown products. Results must be interpreted with the medical history, dose, sample site, decomposition, and possible movement of substances after death.

Postmortem Vitreous Analysis

Laboratory examination of vitreous humor for electrolytes, glucose, ketones, drugs, alcohols, and other analytes. Vitreous potassium may provide a rough postmortem interval estimate, but results require cautious interpretation.

Post-Myocardial Infarction Pericarditis

Inflammation of the sac around the heart that occurs after a heart attack. It may begin soon after the heart attack or develop later as part of a delayed immune reaction.

Postmyocardial Infarction Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Dressler Syndrome*.

Post-Nasal Drip

Alternate name; see *Chronic Rhinitis*.

Postnatal

Relating to the period after birth, especially the newborn and infant period. Postnatal care includes checking breathing, feeding, temperature, weight, jaundice, development, and signs of infection or other illness.

Postnatal Anxiety

Excessive anxiety occurring after childbirth. It may involve persistent worry, panic, intrusive thoughts, restlessness, or physical symptoms and can be treated with therapy, support, and sometimes medicine.

Postnatal Care

Health care for the parent and baby after birth. It includes checking bleeding, blood pressure, wounds, pain, feeding, mood, newborn growth, and warning signs, while providing guidance about recovery, contraception, vaccination, and follow-up.

Post-Natal Depression

Depression beginning during pregnancy or after childbirth, with persistent low mood or loss of interest and possible effects on sleep, bonding, and daily functioning.

Postnatal Depression

Alternate name; see *Post-Natal Depression*.

Post-Obstructive Pneumonia

Lung infection developing beyond a blocked airway. A tumor, inhaled object, thick mucus, or narrowing can prevent drainage and allow infection; antibiotics may not cure it until the blockage is found and relieved.

Postop

Postop is an abbreviation for postoperative, meaning relating to the period after a surgical procedure.

Postoperative

Postoperative means occurring or provided after surgery, including recovery, wound care, pain control, rehabilitation, and complication monitoring.

Post-Operative Atelectasis

Partial collapse of air sacs in the lung after surgery. Anesthesia, pain, shallow breathing, mucus, and lying still can contribute, causing shortness of breath or low oxygen. Pain control, movement, and breathing exercises may help prevent or treat it.

Postoperative Care

Care after surgery that monitors breathing, circulation, pain, fluids, the wound, movement, eating, and possible complications. It may include early walking, exercises, medicines, and prevention of blood clots.

Postoperative Cognitive Dysfunction

Problems with memory, attention, thinking, or planning after surgery. They may be temporary or persistent, especially after major operations; assessment compares the person with their usual abilities and checks for delirium, medicines, infection, or other causes.

Postoperative Complications

Problems that develop after an operation, including infection, bleeding, blood clots, breathing problems, organ dysfunction, wound separation, or medication reactions. Risk depends on the procedure and the person's health; severe pain, fever, breathlessness, or heavy bleeding can signal serious complications.

Postoperative Corneal Edema

Swelling of the cornea after eye surgery, caused by endothelial dysfunction, inflammation, elevated intraocular pressure, or surgical trauma. It can blur vision and may resolve or persist depending on the injury.

Postoperative Delirium

A sudden change in attention and thinking after surgery. A person may become confused, restless, unusually sleepy, or see things that are not there;

symptoms may fluctuate and can reflect medical complications or medication effects.

Postoperative Hemorrhage

Bleeding after surgery that may occur at the operative site or internally and can cause shock, anemia, or the need for urgent intervention.

Postoperative Ileus

Temporary slowing or stopping of bowel movement after surgery, especially abdominal surgery. It can cause bloating, nausea, vomiting, pain, and inability to pass gas or stool; medicines, electrolyte problems, and the operation may contribute.

Postoperative Infection

An infection developing after surgery, involving the incision, an organ space, implanted material, or the bloodstream.

Postoperative Nausea And Vomiting

Nausea, retching, or vomiting occurring after surgery. Risk is influenced by factors such as previous motion sickness or postoperative nausea, anesthetic technique, opioid use, and patient characteristics. Prevention and treatment are tailored to the individual risk and procedure.

Postoperative Period

The postoperative period is the time after an operation when recovery, pain control, wound care, mobility, nutrition, complications, and follow-up are monitored.

Postoperative Pulmonary Complication

A breathing problem developing after surgery, such as partial lung collapse, pneumonia, aspiration, worsening asthma or COPD, or respiratory failure. Risk is reduced by suitable pain control, movement, breathing exercises, and careful monitoring.

Post-Orgasmic Illness Syndrome

A rare condition in which flu-like symptoms, extreme tiredness, headache, nasal or eye symptoms, and difficulty thinking begin soon after orgasm and last for days. The cause is uncertain, and similar symptoms can occur in other conditions.

Postpartum

Relating to the period after childbirth. Recovery includes changes in bleeding, pain, breasts, hormones, sleep, mood, and body function; important complications include heavy bleeding, infection, high blood pressure, blood clots, depression, and psychosis.

Alternate Names:
Puerperium; Postnatal Period

Postpartum Anxiety

Excessive, persistent, or distressing anxiety during pregnancy or after childbirth that interferes with sleep, daily function, bonding, or self-care. It may occur with panic, intrusive worries, or depression; thoughts of self-harm or harm to the baby indicate a psychiatric emergency.

Postpartum Blues

A common, short-lived period of tearfulness, mood changes, irritability, or anxiety beginning soon after childbirth and usually improving within two weeks. Persistent, severe, psychotic, or suicidal symptoms can indicate a postpartum mental-health disorder.

Postpartum Care

Clinical care during the weeks after childbirth that assesses bleeding, uterine involution, blood pressure, infection, wound healing, breastfeeding, mental health, contraception, and recovery.

Postpartum Contraception

Contraceptive counseling and care after childbirth, taking account of breastfeeding, venous-thromboembolism risk, medical conditions, fertility intentions, and the timing of method initiation.

Postpartum Depression

Depression that begins during pregnancy or after childbirth and lasts beyond ordinary short-term mood changes. It may cause persistent sadness, loss of interest, guilt, anxiety, sleep or appetite changes, difficulty bonding, or thoughts of self-harm.

Alternate Names:
PPD; Postnatal Depression

Postpartum Endometritis

Infection of the inner lining of the uterus after childbirth, more common after cesarean birth. It may cause fever, lower-abdominal pain, uterine tenderness, fast heartbeat, or foul-smelling discharge; treatment includes antibiotics.

Post-Partum Haemorrhage

Excessive bleeding after childbirth, most commonly caused by failure of the uterus to contract, retained placental tissue, genital-tract trauma, or clotting problems.

Postpartum Hemorrhage

Excessive bleeding after childbirth, usually caused by poor uterine contraction, retained placental tissue, genital-tract trauma, or a clotting disorder. It can cause shock and is an obstetric emergency.

Postpartum Infection

A bacterial infection of the reproductive tract, surgical site, or adjacent structures occurring following childbirth or abortion (puerperal infection). Commonly manifested as endometritis, wound infection (cesarean incision or perineal laceration/episiotomy), mastitis, or pelvic thrombophlebitis, clinically defined by fever of $\geq 38.0°C$ on two or more postpartum days excluding the first 24 hours. Often polymicrobial involving aerobes and anaerobes; treatment requires broad-spectrum intravenous antibiotics (e.g., clindamycin plus gentamicin for endometritis).

Alternate Names:
Postpartum Infections; Puerperal Infection; Puerperal Sepsis

Postpartum Infections

Plural form; see *Postpartum Infection*.

Postpartum Preeclampsia

New-onset hypertension with pre-eclampsia features after childbirth, sometimes occurring several days or weeks postpartum. Severe headache, visual symptoms, chest pain, shortness of breath, or seizures can occur.

Postpartum Psychosis

A rare but severe psychiatric emergency that can begin suddenly during the days or weeks after childbirth. Symptoms may include hallucinations, delusions, paranoia, severe confusion, mania, depression, disorganized behavior, or rapidly changing moods. It can worsen quickly and threaten the safety of the parent or baby.

Alternate Names:
Puerperal Psychosis; Postnatal Psychosis

Postpartum Thyroiditis

Inflammation of the thyroid during the first year after childbirth, caused by an immune reaction. It may first cause anxiety, sweating, and a fast heartbeat, followed by tiredness, cold intolerance, or low thyroid function; recovery varies.

Postpartum Urinary Retention

Inability to empty the bladder adequately after childbirth, sometimes associated with epidural anesthesia, perineal trauma, swelling, or prolonged labor. Prolonged retention can overdistend and injure the bladder.

Postpericardiotomy Syndrome

An immune-mediated post-cardiac-injury syndrome that develops days to weeks after heart surgery. It may cause fever, pleuritic or positional chest pain, shortness of breath, and fluid around the heart or lungs; symptoms can recur.

Post-Pneumonectomy Syndrome

A rare problem after removal of one lung in which the remaining chest structures shift and press on the airway or major blood vessels. It may cause breathlessness, noisy breathing, repeated infections, or difficulty swallowing.

Post-Polio Syndrome

Progressive muscle weakness, fatigue, and pain that begin many years after recovery from acute poliomyelitis. It typically affects muscles previously

weakened by polio, and sometimes regions thought to have been spared, and is thought to result from slow decline of overworked surviving motor neurons. There is no specific diagnostic test, so other causes of new weakness are excluded first; management is supportive and includes adjusted exercise, energy conservation, and symptom control.

Post-Prandial

Occurring after a meal. Post-prandial blood glucose is used in diabetes testing, while low blood pressure or chest pain after eating may indicate a circulation or heart problem.

Postprandial Period

The postprandial period is the interval after eating when digestion and nutrient absorption occur and glucose, insulin, and other metabolic responses change.

Postrenal AKI

Sudden loss of kidney function caused by blocked urine flow. Prostate enlargement, stones, tumors, scarring, or bladder-nerve problems may be responsible; kidney damage becomes more likely when the blockage is severe or lasts a long time.

Post-Splenectomy Complications

Post-splenectomy complications include infection by encapsulated bacteria, blood clots, bleeding, and changes in blood-cell counts; vaccination and follow-up reduce risk.

Post-Streptococcal Glomerulonephritis

Kidney inflammation that can develop after a group A streptococcal throat or skin infection. It may cause dark urine, swelling, reduced urine, high blood pressure, tiredness, or kidney failure.

Poststreptococcal Glomerulonephritis

Alternate spelling; see *Post-Streptococcal Glomerulonephritis*.

Poststreptococcal Pustulosis

A rare immune-related outbreak of pus-filled spots after a streptococcal throat infection. The spots usually appear on reddened skin of the trunk or limbs and can resemble infection or a medicine reaction.

Post-Surgical Pain

Pain after an operation caused by tissue injury and inflammation. Its severity depends on the procedure and the person; severe pain can limit breathing, movement, sleep, and recovery.

Post-Surgical Rehabilitation

A planned program to restore movement, strength, independence, and safe return to daily activities after surgery. It may include wound care, pain control, exercises, mobility training, and advice tailored to the operation and the person's recovery.

Postsynaptic Membrane

The receiving surface of a nerve or muscle cell where a neighboring nerve releases a chemical signal. Receptors in this surface detect the signal and help start or change an electrical response.

Postsynaptic Potential

A graded, local change in the electrical membrane potential of a postsynaptic neuron or muscle cell generated by the binding of neurotransmitters to ligand-gated receptors, classified as depolarizing excitatory postsynaptic potentials (EPSP) or hyperpolarizing inhibitory postsynaptic potentials (IPSP).

Alternate Names:
PSP

Post-Term Infant

An infant born at or after 42 weeks of gestation, beyond the usual term-pregnancy period; risks depend on placental function, fetal condition, and circumstances of delivery.

Post-Term Pregnancy

Pregnancy lasting 42 completed weeks or longer. The placenta may provide less support, the baby may become unusually large, and amniotic fluid may decrease. Clinicians monitor parent and baby and discuss delivery timing to reduce complications.

Postterm Pregnancy

A pregnancy continuing to 42 weeks or longer. Risks may include reduced placental function, low amniotic fluid, fetal overgrowth, meconium passage, stillbirth, and difficult delivery, so fetal surveillance and delivery planning are considered.

Post-Test Probability

The estimated chance that a person has a disease after a test result is known. It depends on the original likelihood of disease and how accurately the test distinguishes people with and without the condition.

Post-Thrombotic Syndrome

Chronic pain, heaviness, edema, skin change, and sometimes ulceration developing after deep-vein thrombosis because of persistent venous obstruction and valvular damage. Compression, exercise, skin care, and selected interventions may reduce disability.

Post-Transfusion Purpura

A rare immune reaction that causes a severe fall in platelets about 5–10 days after a blood transfusion. It can produce pinpoint skin bleeding, bruising, nosebleeds, or dangerous internal bleeding; treatment may include immunoglobulin or other immune-directed therapy.

Post-Traumatic Headache

A headache beginning or continuing after a head or neck injury. It may resemble migraine or tension headache and can occur with dizziness, poor concentration, sleep problems, nausea, or light sensitivity.

Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder

A mental-health disorder that may follow actual or threatened death, serious injury, sexual violence, or another traumatic event. It causes ongoing unwanted memories, nightmares, avoidance, emotional changes, and heightened alertness that interfere with daily life.

Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD)

Alternate name; see *Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder*.

Posttraumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD)

Alternate name; see *Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder*.

Posttraumatic Stress Syndrome

Older or alternate name for *Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder*.

Postural

Postural means relating to body position or posture, including symptoms or vital signs that change when a person sits, stands, or lies down.

Postural Drainage

Using specific body positions so gravity helps mucus move from smaller airways into larger ones, where it can be coughed out. A respiratory clinician selects positions based on the affected lung area and the person's condition.

Postural Hypotension

A drop in blood pressure after standing that may cause dizziness, blurred vision, weakness, or fainting. It can result from dehydration, medicines, nerve disorders, blood loss, or heart problems and increases fall risk.

Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome

A chronic clinical syndrome of orthostatic intolerance, with frequent symptoms that worsen upright and improve when lying down. Within 10 minutes of standing, heart rate rises by at least 30 beats per minute in adults or 40 beats per minute at ages 12–19, without orthostatic hypotension. Symptoms persist for at least 3 months, and another condition or medicine does not better explain the tachycardia. Symptoms may include lightheadedness, palpitations, fatigue, blurred vision, or exercise intolerance.

Postural Tremor

An involuntary, rhythmic oscillation that appears

when an affected body part is actively maintained against gravity, such as holding the arms outstretched. It is the characteristic tremor of essential tremor and physiologic tremor exaggerated by thyrotoxicosis, stress, or medications.

Posture

The alignment and position of the body while resting or moving. Posture depends on bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vision, and balance and can affect comfort, breathing, movement, and injury risk.

Post-Vasectomy Pain Syndrome

Persistent or recurring testicular or scrotal pain lasting at least three months after vasectomy. The pain may result from nerve irritation, inflammation, or pressure in the reproductive tract.

Alternate Names:
PVPS; Chronic Post-Vasectomy Pain

Post-Void Residual

The amount of urine remaining in the bladder after urination, measured by ultrasound or catheterization. A persistently high residual may indicate incomplete emptying, but its significance depends on the volume, timing, symptoms, and clinical context.

Post-Void Residual Volume

The amount of urine remaining in the bladder immediately after urination, measured by ultrasound or catheterization. An elevated residual suggests incomplete emptying but its significance varies with timing, bladder volume, symptoms, and repeated measurements.

Potassium

The chemical symbol for potassium, a major intracellular electrolyte needed for nerve signaling, muscle contraction, and cardiac electrical activity.

Potassium Acetate

A potassium salt used to replace potassium or provide acetate in selected medical and laboratory applications; dosing requires monitoring of kidney function and serum potassium.

Potassium Binders

Medicines taken by mouth that trap potassium in the intestine so it leaves the body in stool. They help lower persistently high blood potassium in selected people, especially with kidney disease, but require monitoring for constipation, swelling, and other electrolyte changes.

Potassium Carbonate Poisoning

Swallowing potassium carbonate can irritate or burn the mouth, throat, and stomach and may raise blood potassium dangerously. Vomiting, weakness, abnormal heartbeat, or breathing difficulty can occur with severe exposure.

Potassium Channel

A membrane protein that allows potassium ions to cross cells and helps control electrical excitability, heart rhythm, and hormone release.

Potassium Chloride

A salt used to prevent or treat low blood potassium. It may be taken by mouth or given into a vein; too much can cause dangerous heart-rhythm problems, especially when kidney function is reduced.

Potassium Citrate

A medicine that makes urine less acidic and increases urinary citrate, helping prevent some kidney stones. It can dangerously raise blood potassium in people with kidney disease or those taking certain medicines.

Potassium Cyanide

A highly poisonous chemical that prevents cells from using oxygen. Swallowing or inhaling it can rapidly cause headache, confusion, seizures, collapse, heart failure, and death.

Potassium Deficiency

An abnormally low blood potassium level, which can cause weakness, cramps, constipation, abnormal heart rhythms, or paralysis.

Potassium Dichromate

A toxic, corrosive chemical that can burn the skin, eyes, mouth, and digestive tract. Swallowing or inhaling it may damage the kidneys, liver, blood, or lungs.

Potassium Hydroxide Poisoning

A severe chemical burn caused by swallowing or contacting potassium hydroxide, a strong alkali. It can damage the mouth, throat, stomach, skin, eyes, and lungs.

Potassium In Diet

Dietary potassium comes from fruits, vegetables, beans, dairy, and other foods; intake may need adjustment in kidney disease or with medicines that change potassium levels.

Potassium Iodide

Potassium iodide supplies iodide and is used in selected thyroid conditions, radiation emergencies, and some expectorant preparations; excess can disturb thyroid function.

Potassium Ion

The positively charged form of potassium, the principal intracellular cation that helps establish resting membrane potential, nerve transmission, muscle contraction, and cardiac rhythm.

Potassium Permanganate

A chemical sometimes used as a very dilute skin antiseptic or drying solution. Concentrated material can burn tissue, stain skin, and cause poisoning if swallowed.

Potassium-Sparing Diuretic

A class of diuretic medications that promote sodium and water excretion while conserving potassium in the late distal tubule and collecting duct of the nephron. Includes mineralocorticoid receptor antagonists (aldosterone antagonists such as spironolactone and eplerenone) and direct epithelial sodium channel (ENaC) blockers (amiloride, triamterene). Clinically utilized in heart failure with reduced ejection fraction, cirrhosis with ascites, and primary hyperaldosteronism, with hyperkalemia representing the primary adverse effect.

Alternate Names:
Potassium-Sparing Diuretics

Potassium-Sparing Diuretics

Plural form; see *Potassium-Sparing Diuretic*.

Potassium Test

A potassium test measures potassium in blood, usually to assess heart, muscle, kidney, or medication-related electrolyte problems.

Potassium Urine Test

A urine potassium test measures potassium excretion and helps determine whether abnormal blood potassium is related to kidney losses or other causes.

Potbellies And Toddlers

A rounded abdomen in a toddler is often normal body shape or posture; persistent distension with pain, vomiting, poor growth, constipation, or a mass can indicate an underlying disorder.

Potency

The amount of a drug required to produce a specified effect. A more potent drug produces that effect at a lower dose, but potency does not indicate the maximum effect.

Potential

Potential describes a capacity, possibility, or stored energy that may become clinically relevant depending on circumstances and additional findings.

Potential Acuity Meter

An eye-testing device that estimates the vision a person might achieve after treatment of an eye problem such as a cataract. Results can be limited by retinal, nerve, or other disease.

Potocki-Lupski Syndrome

A genetic condition caused by an extra copy of a small section of chromosome 17. It may cause low muscle tone, feeding and growth problems, de-

velopmental or learning difficulties, autism-related features, behavior differences, and congenital heart defects.

Alternate Names:
PTLS; Duplication 17p11.2 Syndrome

Pott Disease

Tuberculosis infection of the bones of the spine. It can cause persistent back pain, collapse or bending of the spine, an abscess, and pressure on the spinal cord leading to weakness or paralysis.

Potter Sequence

A cascade of neonatal physical anomalies resulting directly from severe oligohydramnios in utero (frequently caused by bilateral renal agenesis or posterior urethral valves), comprising pulmonary hypoplasia, compressed dysmorphic facial features (Potter facies), and extremity limb positioning deformities.

Potter Syndrome

A pattern of birth abnormalities caused by very low amniotic fluid, often because both fetal kidneys are absent or cannot make urine. It may cause underdeveloped lungs, distinctive facial features, and limb changes and is usually life-threatening.

Pott Puffy Tumor

A subperiosteal abscess of the frontal bone associated with underlying frontal bone osteomyelitis, arising as a severe suppurative complication of untreated frontal sinusitis or direct cranial trauma, presenting with fluctuant forehead swelling and headache.

Alternate Names:
Frontal Subperiosteal Abscess; Frontal Bone Osteomyelitis

Pott's Disease

Tuberculosis infection of the spine, usually affecting the vertebrae. It can cause gradually worsening back pain; vertebral damage may lead to collapse, spinal curvature, an abscess, or pressure on the spinal cord or nerves.

Pouch

A sac-like body structure or a surgically created reservoir. Examples include a cheek pouch, a pouch in the digestive tract, and an ileal pouch made from small intestine.

Pouch of Douglas

A space in the pelvis between the uterus and rectum. In a person without a uterus, the comparable space lies between the bladder and rectum; fluid or blood can collect there.

Pound

A unit measuring weight or force, with meaning determined by context. In healthcare, pounds may describe body weight, pressure, equipment loads, or medicine instructions and should be distinguished from metric units.

Povidone

Povidone is a water-soluble polymer used in medicines, eye products, and other preparations; it is also part of povidone-iodine antiseptic.

Povidone-Iodine

Povidone-iodine is an iodine-containing antiseptic used on skin or tissue before selected procedures; it can irritate skin and affect the thyroid with extensive use.

Powassan Encephalitis

Inflammation of the brain caused by Powassan virus, a tick-borne flavivirus. It can cause fever, headache, vomiting, confusion, seizures, or weakness and may require hospitalization.

Powassan Virus

A tick-borne virus that can cause encephalitis or meningitis. Severe infection may cause headache, fever, confusion, seizures, or weakness; there is no specific antiviral treatment.

Powassan Virus Disease

Powassan virus disease is a rare tick-borne infection that can cause fever, headache, vomiting, confusion,

seizures, meningitis, or encephalitis. Treatment is supportive, and prevention relies on avoiding ticks and removing them promptly.

Powder Diffraction

An analytical method that identifies crystalline substances by measuring how an X-ray or other beam is diffracted by powdered material.

Power

The rate at which work is performed; in exercise, it combines force and movement speed.

Power Training

Exercise designed to improve the ability to produce force rapidly.

Alternate Names:
Explosive Strength Training; Ballistic Training

Pox

A disease producing vesicles, pustules, or pitted scars; the term is used in names such as smallpox and cowpox.

Poxviridae

A family of large DNA viruses that includes orthopoxviruses, molluscipoxvirus, and parapoxviruses; some cause significant human disease.

Poxviridae Infection

An infection caused by a poxvirus, ranging from localized skin lesions to severe systemic disease depending on the virus and host.

Poxvirus

A family of large DNA viruses that includes variola, vaccinia, mpox, and molluscum contagiosum viruses.

Ppar Alpha

A protein inside cells that helps control how the body uses fats. Fibrate medicines activate it to lower some blood fats, especially triglycerides.

Ppar Delta

A protein inside cells that helps regulate fat use, energy balance, inflammation, and the development of some tissues. It is mainly studied in laboratory and drug research.

PPD

An abbreviation for *purified protein derivative*, the tuberculin used in a tuberculosis skin test, or for *postpartum depression*, a depressive disorder arising during the postpartum period. Spell out the term when the context is not clear.

PPD Skin Test

A PPD skin test places a small amount of tuberculin under the skin to assess immune evidence of tuberculosis exposure; interpretation depends on risk and the size of the reaction.

PPH

Abbreviation; see *Postpartum Hemorrhage*.

PPS (Post-Polio Syndrome)

Alternate name; see *Post-Polio Syndrome*.

Practitioner

A person qualified and authorized to practice a healthcare profession.

Prader-Labhart-Willi Fancone Syndrome

Historical or variant naming for Prader-Willi syndrome, a chromosome 15 imprinting disorder causing infantile hypotonia and feeding difficulty followed by hyperphagia, obesity risk, hypogonadism, developmental differences, and short stature.

Prader-Labhart-Willi Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Prader-Willi Syndrome*.

Prader Willi Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Prader-Willi Syndrome*.

Prader-Willi Syndrome

A genetic disorder that often causes weak muscle tone and feeding difficulty in infancy, followed later

by unusually strong hunger, obesity, short stature, learning difficulties, hormone problems, and behavioral changes.

Alternate Names:
Prader-Labhart-Willi Syndrome

Pragmatic

Focused on what works in ordinary real-world conditions. A pragmatic clinical trial studies how an intervention performs in usual healthcare rather than under highly controlled conditions.

Pragmatic Trial

A pragmatic trial evaluates an intervention under usual real-world care conditions to estimate how well it works in routine practice.

Pralatrexate

A folate-blocking chemotherapy medicine used for some relapsed or treatment-resistant peripheral T-cell lymphomas. It can cause mouth sores, low blood counts, infection, fatigue, nausea, and other serious treatment-related effects.

Pralidoxime

An oxime that can reactivate inhibited acetylcholinesterase when administered early after organophosphate poisoning, particularly for nicotinic weakness and respiratory-muscle dysfunction. It is used with atropine and supportive care according to exposure and local guidance.

Pramipexole

A medicine that stimulates dopamine receptors and is used mainly for Parkinson disease or restless legs syndrome. It can cause nausea, sleepiness, dizziness, sudden sleep, hallucinations, or impulse-control problems.

Prandial

Prandial means relating to a meal, as in preprandial before eating or postprandial after eating.

Prasugrel

An antiplatelet medicine that prevents blood cells from clumping. It is used in selected people with acute coronary syndrome receiving coronary stents, but it increases bleeding risk and is unsuitable for some patients.

Pravastatin

A statin that lowers LDL cholesterol by inhibiting HMG-CoA reductase.

Pravastatin Sodium

A statin medicine that lowers harmful LDL cholesterol by reducing cholesterol production in the liver. It helps reduce heart attack and stroke risk alongside diet, exercise, and other risk-factor treatment.

Praziquantel

A medicine used to treat several infections caused by parasitic worms, including schistosomiasis, tapeworms, and flukes. It damages the worms so the body can remove them; dizziness, sleepiness, nausea, or abdominal discomfort may occur.

Prealbumin

Another name for transthyretin, a protein made mainly by the liver that carries thyroid hormone and vitamin A in the blood. Its blood level changes with inflammation, illness, kidney disease, and nutrition, so it is not a nutrition measure by itself.

Prealbumin Tyr-77 Amyloidosis

A rare hereditary transthyretin amyloidosis caused by a Tyr77 transthyretin variant. Misfolded protein can deposit in nerves, the heart, or other organs and may cause neuropathy, cardiomyopathy, or gastrointestinal symptoms.

Preauricular Sinuses

Small congenital pits or channels near the front of the ear caused by incomplete fusion during development. They may remain harmless or become infected, swollen, painful, or draining; recurrent infection may require surgical excision.

Prebiotics

Substrates selectively utilized by host microorgan-

isms that confer a health benefit. Many recognized prebiotics are fermentable carbohydrates, but not all dietary fibers are prebiotics.

Pre-Cancerous

Describing abnormal cells or tissue that are not cancer but have a higher-than-usual chance of becoming cancer. The risk varies by the tissue and the severity of change; monitoring or removal may reduce the risk.

Precancerous Condition

A precancerous condition contains abnormal changes that may progress to cancer but are not cancer themselves.

Precancerous Polyp

A precancerous polyp is a growth with cellular changes that can become cancerous over time if not removed or monitored appropriately.

Precapillary Sphincter

A ring of muscle at the entrance to some capillaries that helps control how much blood flows into a capillary network.

Precaution

An action taken in advance to lower the chance of harm, infection, or error. Examples include handwashing, protective equipment, checking a medicine, using a seat belt, and avoiding a known trigger.

Precipitate Labor

Labor and birth completed unusually quickly, commonly defined as delivery within three hours after regular contractions begin. It may increase the risk of birth before arrival at a facility, injury, or heavy bleeding, though outcomes vary.

Alternate Names:
Precipitate Labour; Precipitous Labor; Precipitous Labour; Tumultuous Labor; Rapid Delivery

Precipitating Factor

A precipitating factor is an event or exposure that triggers the onset or worsening of symptoms or disease in a susceptible person.

Precision Medicine

An approach to preventing, diagnosing, or treating disease that uses information about a person's genes, proteins, environment, lifestyle, and other characteristics to guide care. It is sometimes called personalized medicine, though precision medicine is often preferred because it does not imply a unique treatment for each individual.

Precision Oncology

An approach to cancer diagnosis and treatment that uses information about a tumor's molecular features, such as gene changes, proteins, or other biomarkers, to guide disease characterization, treatment selection, or clinical-trial matching. These findings are interpreted alongside cancer type, stage, and other clinical features; an actionable biomarker does not guarantee a treatment response.

Preclinical

Before human testing, or describing disease changes that occur before symptoms become noticeable or cause recognized illness.

Precocious Puberty

Development of puberty-related body changes earlier than expected. It may result from early brain signals, hormone-producing disorders, medicines, or other conditions and requires evaluation to protect growth and emotional wellbeing.

Alternate Names:
Early Puberty Premature Puberty

Preconception Care

Health care before pregnancy to improve the chance of a healthy pregnancy. It reviews medical conditions, medicines, vaccinations, genetic risks, nutrition, folic acid, substance exposure, and lifestyle, and helps plan changes before conception.

Preconception Counseling

Healthcare advice before pregnancy to improve the health of the pregnant person and future baby. It reviews medicines, vaccines, chronic diseases, nutri-

tion, genetic risks, harmful exposures, and recommended supplements.

Precordial Catch Syndrome

Brief, sharp, localized chest pain near the heart that worsens with breathing and usually occurs in otherwise healthy children or adolescents.

Precordium

The area of the front chest wall over the heart and nearby large blood vessels. A clinician examines this area by looking, feeling for the heartbeat or unusual movement, and listening for heart sounds and murmurs.

Precursor

A substance that the body can change into another substance with a useful biological effect. For example, some vitamins, hormones, and medicines begin as precursors and are changed by enzymes in particular tissues.

Prediabetes

Blood glucose higher than normal but below the diagnostic threshold for diabetes, usually identified by A1C, fasting glucose, or an oral glucose-tolerance test; it increases future diabetes and cardiovascular risk.

Alternate Names:
Borderline Diabetes; Impaired Glucose Tolerance; Impaired Fasting Glucose

Prediabetes Syndrome

Blood glucose levels above normal but below the diabetes threshold, associated with increased future risk of type 2 diabetes and cardiovascular disease.

Predictive Test

A test that estimates whether a person or disease is likely to respond to a particular treatment.

Predispose

To predispose is to increase a person's susceptibility or likelihood of developing a disease or response when additional triggers occur.

Prednimustine

Prednimustine is a former antineoplastic drug combining a corticosteroid-related group with an alkylating component and causing immunosuppression and marrow toxicity.

Prednisolone

Prednisolone is a corticosteroid used to reduce inflammation and immune activity; prolonged or high-dose use can cause infection, bone loss, and other effects.

Prednisone

A corticosteroid used for inflammatory, allergic, and autoimmune conditions. Long-term or high-dose use can suppress adrenal function, so stopping after prolonged use may require gradual dose reduction to avoid adrenal insufficiency.

Pre-eclampsia

Alternate spelling; see *Preeclampsia*.

Preeclampsia

A disorder that can develop during pregnancy, usually after 20 weeks, or during the weeks after childbirth. It involves new high blood pressure together with protein in the urine or signs of organ injury. Possible findings include a low platelet count, abnormal kidney or liver function, severe headache, vision changes, upper-abdominal pain, or fluid in the lungs. During pregnancy, it can affect the placenta and fetal growth. It may progress to eclampsia, which is preeclampsia with seizures.

Preeclampsia and Eclampsia

Alternate name; see *Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia*.

Preeclampsia And High Blood Pressure

Alternate name; see *Preeclampsia*.

Preeclampsia With Severe Features

A severe form of preeclampsia involving very high blood pressure or damage to organs such as the brain, liver, kidneys, lungs, or blood-clotting system.

Severe headache, vision changes, breathing difficulty, or upper-abdominal pain may occur.

Preexcitation Syndrome

A heart-rhythm condition in which an extra electrical pathway activates the lower heart chambers too early. It can cause episodes of a very fast heartbeat, dizziness, or fainting and may require specialist assessment.

Pre-Existing Diabetes And Pregnancy

Pre-existing type 1 or type 2 diabetes during pregnancy increases risks to parent and fetus, so glucose control, medicines, fetal growth, blood pressure, and eye and kidney health need coordinated care.

Prefrontal

Relating to the anterior part of the frontal lobe involved in planning, judgment, working memory, and behavior.

Prefrontal Cortex

The prefrontal cortex is the front part of the frontal lobe involved in planning, judgment, working memory, impulse control, and social behavior.

Pregabalin

Pregabalin is used for certain nerve pain and seizures and may cause dizziness, sleepiness, swelling, or dependence.

Preganglionic Fiber

A nerve fiber that carries automatic body signals from the brain or spinal cord to a relay station before they reach an organ. These signals help control the heart, blood vessels, glands, digestion, and bladder.

Pregnancy

The period during which an embryo or fetus develops in the uterus, usually lasting about 40 weeks from the first day of the last menstrual period until birth.

Pregnancy And Herpes

Genital herpes during pregnancy can affect delivery planning and rarely infect the newborn; antiviral treatment and examination of lesions near labor help reduce transmission risk.

Pregnancy And Travel

Travel during pregnancy depends on gestational age, health, destination infections, transport, and access to care; prevention includes vaccines as appropriate, food and water safety, movement, and medical planning.

Pregnancy and Urolithiasis

Kidney or ureteral stones during pregnancy can cause colicky flank pain, hematuria, nausea, obstruction, infection, or preterm contractions. Ultrasound is generally preferred for initial imaging, and treatment balances symptom control, drainage, infection management, and fetal safety.

Pregnancy And Work

Work during pregnancy is usually possible but may require adjustments for heavy lifting, prolonged standing, heat, chemicals, radiation, infection, night work, or other occupational hazards.

Pregnancy at Age 35 or Older

Pregnancy in a person who will be 35 years or older at the estimated time of delivery. It is associated with increased risks of some chromosomal conditions and pregnancy complications; individual risk depends on overall health and pregnancy history.

Alternate Names:
Advanced Maternal Age

Pregnancy: Bleeding During The First Trimester

First-trimester bleeding may occur with implantation, cervical changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, or other causes. Assessment uses symptoms, examination, serial pregnancy hormone testing, and ultrasound; heavy bleeding, severe pain, faintness, or shoulder pain is urgent.

Pregnancy Complication

A maternal, fetal, placental, or labor-related problem that disrupts an otherwise expected pregnancy, such as preeclampsia, hemorrhage, diabetes, growth

restriction, or preterm labor.

Pregnancy Diagnosis

Confirmation of pregnancy using a urine or blood test for human chorionic gonadotropin, followed by ultrasound when needed to establish location, viability, and gestational age. A positive test with pain or bleeding requires assessment for ectopic pregnancy.

Pregnancy-Induced Hypertension

Alternate name; see *Gestational Hypertension*.

Pregnancy Nutrition

Food and supplements during pregnancy that support the pregnant person and fetal growth. Needs vary, but a varied diet usually includes enough protein, folate, iron, iodine, calcium, vitamin D, and other nutrients; individual advice is important.

Pregnancy Of Unknown Location

A positive pregnancy test without a confirmed intrauterine or ectopic pregnancy on ultrasound. Serial human chorionic gonadotropin measurements and repeat imaging help determine whether the pregnancy is early, failing, or ectopic.

Pregnancy Outcome

Pregnancy outcome describes what happens to a pregnancy, such as live birth, miscarriage, stillbirth, preterm birth, or other maternal or fetal result.

Pregnancy: Placenta Previa

Placenta previa occurs when the placenta lies over or near the cervical opening and can cause painless bright-red bleeding, especially later in pregnancy. Digital vaginal examination is avoided until location is known; recurrent bleeding requires obstetric planning and sometimes cesarean delivery.

Pregnancy: Preeclampsia And Eclampsia

Preeclampsia is new hypertension during pregnancy with proteinuria or organ dysfunction; eclampsia is the occurrence of seizures. Severe headache, visual symptoms, upper-abdominal pain, shortness of breath, or seizure can occur in severe disease.

Alternate Names:
Toxemia of Pregnancy; Hypertensive Disorders of Pregnancy

Pregnancy-Related Hypertension

High blood pressure that develops during pregnancy. Gestational hypertension is new high blood pressure after 20 weeks without signs of preeclampsia; preeclampsia includes protein in the urine or other signs of organ involvement.

Pregnancy Status

Pregnancy status indicates whether a person is pregnant, not pregnant, or of unknown status and can affect medication, imaging, and treatment decisions.

Pregnancy Test

A urine or blood test that detects human chorionic gonadotropin, a hormone made soon after an embryo attaches to the uterus. Testing too early can be falsely negative; an unexpected result may need repeat testing or medical assessment.

Pregnancy Trauma

Physical injury during pregnancy, including falls, motor-vehicle crashes, assault, or abdominal impact. Maternal stabilization comes first, followed by assessment for placental abruption, bleeding, uterine injury, fetal compromise, and preterm labor.

Pregnancy Trimester

One of three approximate stages of pregnancy: first through 13 weeks, second from 14 through 27 weeks, and third from 28 weeks until birth. The stages help organize fetal development, screening, and care.

Pregnancy With Asthma

Asthma during pregnancy may change as hormone, breathing, and immune conditions change. Poorly controlled asthma can reduce oxygen for the pregnant person and fetus, so prescribed controller treatment and regular obstetric and respiratory follow-up are important.

Pregnane

Pregnane is a 21-carbon steroid hydrocarbon that forms the structural backbone of progesterone and several corticosteroid and progestin compounds.

Pregnanolone

Pregnanolone is a neuroactive steroid metabolite that can modulate GABA-A receptors and influence neuronal excitability, mood, and sedation.

Pregnant

Pregnant means carrying a developing embryo or fetus in the uterus after conception; pregnancy status affects medicines, imaging, and clinical decisions.

Pregnenolone

Pregnenolone is a steroid hormone precursor made from cholesterol that can be converted into progesterone, corticosteroids, and sex hormones.

Prehn Sign

A test in which lifting the painful testicle is said to relieve pain in epididymitis but not testicular torsion. This finding is unreliable and cannot rule out torsion. Sudden severe testicle pain, swelling, nausea, or a high-riding testicle can indicate torsion, which may require Doppler ultrasound and surgery.

Alternate Names:
Prehn's Sign

Prehypertension

An older blood-pressure category formerly used for readings above normal but below hypertension. Current thresholds and terminology vary by guideline; see *Elevated Blood Pressure*.

Preimplantation Genetic Diagnosis

Genetic testing of embryos created through in-vitro fertilization before transfer to the uterus, used to identify selected inherited disorders or chromosomal abnormalities. It requires genetic counseling and does not guarantee implantation, a healthy pregnancy, or absence of all disease.

Preimplantation Genetic Testing

Genetic testing of cells from an embryo created through in-vitro fertilization before possible transfer to the uterus, used in selected situations to identify specific inherited disorders or chromosome-number abnormalities.

Preload

The amount of blood filling the heart's lower chambers and stretching their muscle just before each heartbeat. It mainly depends on blood returning to the heart and influences how strongly the heart can pump.

Preload Reduction

A decrease in the amount of blood returning to the heart, which lowers the heart's filling pressure and workload. It may occur with fluid loss or medicines and can help some forms of heart failure.

Premalignant

Describing cells or tissue changes that have a higher chance of becoming cancer but have not grown into nearby tissues. Not every premalignant change becomes cancer; follow-up or removal depends on its type, location, size, and risk.

Premalignant Lesions of the Endometrium

Abnormal endometrial gland growth, usually endometrial hyperplasia with atypia, that can precede endometrial carcinoma. Diagnosis requires sampling of the uterine lining; treatment depends on fertility goals, cancer risk, and whether invasion is present.

Premature

Occurring earlier than expected or before the usual developmental or pregnancy-related time. A premature birth occurs before thirty-seven completed weeks and may increase risks involving breathing, feeding, temperature, and development.

Premature Adrenarche

Early appearance of pubic or axillary hair, body odor, or mild acne from adrenal androgen production without true central puberty; evaluation ex-

cludes virilizing disorders.

Premature Atrial Contraction

An early heartbeat that starts in the upper chambers of the heart rather than at the usual pacemaker. It may feel like a skipped or extra beat and is often harmless; frequent episodes or fainting can occur with an arrhythmia.

Premature Baby

An infant born before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy, with risks related to immature lungs, brain, feeding, temperature control, immunity, and other organ systems.

Premature Birth

Birth before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy; the earlier the birth, the greater the risks of respiratory, neurological, and developmental complications.

Premature Closure

Closing of a body opening, growth plate, or developmental connection earlier than expected. The result depends on the site and may include blockage, abnormal body shape, or restricted growth; treatment depends on the cause.

Premature Ejaculation

A persistent or recurrent pattern of ejaculation that occurs sooner than desired, with limited control and associated personal distress. Assessment considers the person's typical experience and sexual context.

Alternate Names:
Rapid Ejaculation; PE

Premature Infant

An infant born before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy. Earlier birth increases the risk of breathing, feeding, temperature-control, infection, and developmental problems.

Premature Labor

Regular uterine contractions with cervical change before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy, which can lead to preterm birth; clinical assessment considers membranes, infection, and fetal well-being.

Premature Menopause

Loss of ovarian function and menstruation before age 40, now often termed primary ovarian insufficiency.

Premature Ovarian Failure

Older name; see *Premature Ovarian Insufficiency*.

Premature Ovarian Insufficiency

Reduced or intermittent ovarian function before age 40, causing irregular or absent periods, reduced fertility, and sometimes hot flushes, vaginal dryness, or low bone density. Causes include genetic conditions, autoimmune disease, chemotherapy, radiation, surgery, or no identifiable cause.

Premature Puberty

Alternate name; see *Precocious Puberty*.

Premature Rupture Of Membranes

Breaking of the amniotic sac before labor begins. If it happens before 37 weeks, it is called preterm rupture; a gush or continuing leak of fluid can precede infection or early birth.

Premature Thelarche

Isolated breast development in a young child without other signs of puberty, often transient but assessed for growth acceleration, estrogen exposure, or true precocious puberty.

Premature Ventricular Contraction

An extra, abnormal heartbeat that originates in one of the heart's lower pumping chambers (the ventricles) ahead of the normal regular rhythm. This premature impulse disrupts the normal heart cycle, often felt as a flutter, a skipped beat, or a forceful thump in the chest followed by a brief pause. While isolated PVCs are common and generally harmless in people with healthy hearts, frequent occurrences can be associated with underlying heart conditions.

Alternate Names:
Premature Ventricular Contractions; PVC; Ventric-

ular Premature Depolarization; VPD; Ventricular Extrasystole

Premature Ventricular Contractions

Plural form; see *Premature Ventricular Contraction*.

Prematurity

Alternate name; see *Preterm Birth*.

Premenstrual

Occurring during the days before menstruation; the term commonly refers to cyclical symptoms such as mood change, breast tenderness, bloating, headache, or fatigue.

Premenstrual Breast Changes

Premenstrual breast changes include cyclic fullness, tenderness, swelling, or lumpiness caused by hormonal variation; a persistent one-sided mass, skin change, or bloody discharge can have other causes.

Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder

A severe form of premenstrual symptoms that repeatedly causes depression, irritability, anxiety, mood swings, or loss of control along with physical symptoms and major disruption of work, relationships, or daily life before menstruation.

Premenstrual Syndrome

A recurring group of physical and emotional symptoms in the days or weeks before menstruation that improves when bleeding begins. Symptoms may include irritability, mood changes, bloating, breast tenderness, headache, tiredness, or appetite changes.

Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS)

Alternate name; see *Premenstrual Syndrome*.

Pre-MiRNA

A pre-miRNA is an early hairpin-shaped microRNA transcript processed in the nucleus before becoming a mature regulator of gene expression.

Premolar Tooth

One of the permanent teeth between the canine teeth and molars. Premolars usually have two raised points and help tear and crush food; decay, crowding, or infection may require dental treatment.

Prenatal

Prenatal means occurring during pregnancy before birth, including care, testing, development, counseling, and treatment of the pregnant person or fetus.

Prenatal Care

Regular health care during pregnancy to monitor the pregnant person and developing baby. Visits may include blood-pressure and urine checks, blood tests, ultrasound, screening, vaccination, nutrition and medicine review, and advice about warning signs.

Prenatal Depression

Depression during pregnancy. Symptoms may include persistent sadness, loss of interest, guilt, hopelessness, sleep or appetite changes, and thoughts of self-harm; prompt professional support is important.

Prenatal Development

Prenatal development is growth and differentiation of the embryo and fetus from conception to birth, influenced by genes, nutrition, maternal health, and exposures.

Prenatal Diagnosis

Testing during pregnancy to identify a possible genetic, chromosome, or structural condition in the fetus. It may use ultrasound, blood-based screening, or diagnostic tests such as chorionic-villus sampling and amniocentesis, depending on the clinical question and stage of pregnancy.

Prenatal Exposure

Contact of a fetus with a medicine, substance, infection, or environmental factor during pregnancy. Effects depend on the agent, dose, timing, and fetal susceptibility.

Prenatal Genetic Counseling

A consultation that reviews the risk of inherited or chromosomal conditions, available screening and diagnostic tests, possible results, and reproductive options before or during pregnancy.

Prenatal Sex Determination

Estimation of fetal sex before birth, usually by ultrasound visualization of external genitalia or analysis of placental cell-free DNA for sex-chromosome signals. Ultrasound findings depend on gestational age, fetal position, and image quality; cell-free DNA provides a screening result, not a diagnosis. Sex chromosomes and genital appearance may not align in some differences of sex development.

Alternate Names:
Fetal Sex Determination

Prenatal Testing

Screening and diagnostic tests performed during pregnancy to assess fetal health and development or identify genetic, chromosomal, and structural conditions. Tests may include ultrasound, maternal blood tests, cell-free DNA screening, chorionic-villus sampling, and amniocentesis.

Prenatal Vitamins

Supplements designed to provide nutrients needed during pregnancy, commonly including folic acid, iron, iodine, and vitamin D. The appropriate product and dose depend on diet, medical conditions, laboratory results, and pregnancy needs; excessive doses can be harmful.

Prenylation

A cell process that attaches a fat-like group to a protein, helping direct where the protein works and how it interacts with other proteins. Abnormal prenylation can contribute to some inherited disorders and cancers.

Preop

Preop is an abbreviation for preoperative, meaning relating to preparation and assessment before surgery.

Preoperative Assessment

A medical review before surgery that checks illnesses, medicines, allergies, previous anesthesia problems, heart and lung function, and the airway. Tests are ordered when indicated, and correctable risks are addressed before anesthesia and the operation.

Preoperative Care

Assessment and preparation before an operation. It may include reviewing illnesses and medicines, checking allergies, performing needed tests, explaining anesthesia and recovery, planning fasting and medicines, and reducing risks such as infection or blood clots.

Preoperative Evaluation

Medical assessment before surgery to identify and reduce risks. It reviews health history, medicines, allergies, physical findings, needed tests, anesthesia concerns, and preparations that improve safety during and after surgery.

Preoptic Area

The preoptic area is a hypothalamic region involved in temperature regulation, sleep, reproductive behavior, and hormone control.

Prepubertal

Prepubertal means before the physical and hormonal changes of puberty have begun or progressed to reproductive maturity.

Prepuce

A fold of skin covering and protecting the end of an external sex organ. The penile prepuce is the foreskin over the head of the penis; the clitoral prepuce is the hood over the clitoris.

Prerenal Azotemia

A rise in kidney waste products because the kidneys receive too little effective blood flow, without initial damage to the kidney tissue itself. Dehydration, blood loss, severe infection, heart failure, or liver disease may cause it and can lead to kidney injury if untreated.

Presbyacusis

Alternate spelling; see *Presbycusis*.

Presbycusis

Gradual hearing loss in both ears as a person ages, often affecting high-pitched sounds first. It can make speech harder to understand, especially in noisy places.

Presbyopia

The gradual loss of the eye's ability to focus on nearby objects with age. It commonly causes difficulty reading small print or doing close work and is corrected with reading glasses, contact lenses, or other prescribed lenses.

Presbyphonia

Age-related changes in the voice caused by thinning or weakening of the vocal folds and changes in the voice box. It may produce a weak, breathy, rough, or quieter voice.

Preschooler Development

Preschooler development includes rapid gains in language, motor skills, thinking, self-care, play, and social-emotional regulation; milestones vary, but loss of skills warrants assessment.

Preschooler Test Or Procedure Preparation

Preparing a preschooler for a test or procedure uses simple explanations, play, comfort objects, and caregiver support while following any fasting or medicine instructions.

Prescription

A written or electronic instruction from an authorized healthcare prescriber for a medicine, device, or treatment. It states what is needed and how to use it, allowing a pharmacy or service to provide care safely.

Prescription Drug Misuse

Use of prescription medicines in a way not directed by a clinician, including taking someone else's medicine, taking extra doses, or using them for intoxication; dependence, overdose, and interactions may result.

Prescription Medications

Pharmaceutical drugs that require authorization from a licensed healthcare provider before they can be dispensed to a patient. These medications are regulated because they carry risks that necessitate professional oversight, including potential side effects, drug interactions, and the need for precise dosing.

Presenilin

Presenilin is a component of the gamma-secretase complex that processes membrane proteins; inherited variants can cause familial early-onset Alzheimer disease.

Presentation

The part of a fetus that is directed toward the birth canal, or the symptoms and signs with which a patient seeks care.

Preseptal Cellulitis

An infection of the eyelid and tissues around the eye, without infection inside the eye socket. It causes redness, swelling, pain, and fever; pain with eye movement, reduced vision, or a bulging eye may indicate deeper orbital infection.

Alternate Names:
Periorbital Cellulitis

Preservation

Maintenance of tissue, cells, organs, or function by preventing deterioration.

Preservative

A substance added to food, medicine, or cosmetics to prevent microbial growth or chemical breakdown.

Pressor

Raising blood pressure, usually by tightening blood vessels or increasing heart output. Pressor medicines may treat dangerously low blood pressure but re-

quire monitoring because they can reduce circulation to some tissues.

Pressoreceptor

A pressure-sensitive receptor, especially a baroreceptor in the carotid sinus or aortic arch, that detects arterial stretch and helps regulate heart rate and blood pressure.

Pressure

Force applied over a particular area. Medical pressure measurements include blood pressure, pressure inside the skull, eye pressure, and airway pressure, and abnormal values can damage organs or impair function.

Pressure Atrophy

Thinning or wasting of tissue caused by prolonged pressure. Pressure can compress small blood vessels, reduce oxygen delivery, and gradually damage the affected tissue; the result depends on its location and duration.

Pressure-Flow Study

A bladder test that measures pressure while the bladder fills and while a person urinates, together with urine flow. It helps identify blockage or weak bladder muscle when difficulty emptying cannot be explained by symptoms alone.

Pressure Injury

Localized damage to the skin or underlying soft tissue, usually over a bony area or beneath a medical device, caused by sustained pressure or pressure combined with shear.

Pressure Sore

Alternate name; see *Pressure Injury*.

Pressure Sores

Plural form; see *Pressure Injury*.

Pressure Support Ventilation

A ventilator mode in which the machine gives extra pressure with each breath the person starts, making breathing easier and reducing the work of the breathing muscles. It is often used while reducing ventilator support.

Pressure Ulcer

Alternate name; see *Pressure Injury*.

Pressure Ulcer Prevention

Measures that reduce prolonged pressure and tissue injury, including repositioning, support surfaces, skin inspection, moisture control, nutrition, and mobility.

Pressure Urticaria

A form of chronic inducible urticaria in which sustained pressure causes localized swelling, erythema, and pain, usually after a delay of several hours. Lesions may last 8 to 72 hours and commonly affect the hands, feet, buttocks, or areas compressed by clothing or sitting.

Pre-Synaptic

Located before a synapse, especially on the nerve ending that releases a chemical messenger. Presynaptic activity controls how much signal reaches the next nerve cell, muscle, or gland.

Presynaptic Terminals

Presynaptic terminals are the ends of neurons that release neurotransmitters into synapses in response to electrical activity.

Presyncope

A feeling that fainting is about to occur without actually losing consciousness. It may cause lightheadedness, weakness, sweating, nausea, or blurred vision and can result from low blood pressure, dehydration, abnormal heart rhythm, medicines, or other illness.

Preterm Birth

Delivery before 37 completed weeks of gestation. It may occur spontaneously after preterm labor or preterm prelabor rupture of membranes, or be initiated for maternal or fetal indications. Births are

classified as extremely preterm (before 28 weeks), very preterm (28 to less than 32 weeks), or moderate to late preterm (32 to less than 37 weeks).

Alternate Names:
Premature Birth; Preterm Delivery

Preterm Infant

A baby born before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy. Earlier birth increases the chance of breathing, feeding, temperature-control, infection, and developmental problems; care depends on the baby's maturity, weight, and health.

Preterm Labor

Regular uterine contractions causing cervical change before 37 weeks gestation. Risk factors include prior preterm delivery, multiple gestation, infection, and cervical insufficiency. Diagnosis requires regular contractions with documented cervical change.

Preterm Labor and Birth

Regular uterine contractions causing cervical change before 37 completed weeks, potentially leading to preterm birth. Management depends on gestational age, membranes, infection, fetal status, and cause and may include corticosteroids, magnesium sulfate, antibiotics, or transfer to specialist care.

Preterm Premature Rupture Of Membranes

Breaking of the amniotic sac before labor begins and before 37 completed weeks of pregnancy. It may cause a gush or continuing leak of fluid and increases the risks of infection, early birth, and problems from too little amniotic fluid.

Pretest Probability

The estimated probability that a patient has a disease before the result of a diagnostic test is known. It is based on prevalence, symptoms, examination findings, risk factors, and prior test results and informs test selection and interpretation.

Pretibial Myxedema

An autoimmune skin manifestation of Graves disease, also called thyroid dermopathy, caused by glycosaminoglycan accumulation in the dermis. It produces firm, usually non-pitting thickening or plaques over the shins and may also affect the feet; diffuse, plaque, nodular, and elephantiasic forms occur.

Alternate Names:
Graves Dermopathy; Thyroid Dermopathy; Localized Myxedema

Pretibial Myxoedema

British spelling; see *Pretibial Myxedema*.

Prevalence

The proportion of people in a defined population who have a disease or characteristic at a particular time or during a stated period. It includes both newly diagnosed and previously existing cases.

Prevention Of Liver Cancer

Measures that lower the risk of liver cancer, especially preventing or treating chronic hepatitis B or C, limiting alcohol, avoiding tobacco, maintaining a healthy weight, and managing metabolic liver disease. People at high risk may need regular surveillance.

Preventive Dentistry

Dental care that lowers the risk of tooth decay, gum disease, and tooth loss. It includes brushing with fluoride toothpaste, cleaning between teeth, protective sealants when appropriate, healthy eating advice, and regular dental examinations.

Preventive Health Care

Preventive health care aims to prevent disease or detect it early through vaccination, screening, healthy behaviors, and routine medical care.

Preventive Medicine

The medical field focused on preventing illness and promoting health through individual care, screening, vaccination, and community programs.

Prevertebral Air

Air seen in the soft tissues in front of the spine on

a neck X-ray. It can indicate injury or a hole in the swallowing or breathing passages, a deep infection, or recent surgery.

Priapism

An erection that lasts more than four hours and is not caused by sexual stimulation. The common low-flow type is painful and occurs when blood cannot drain from the penis; the less common type follows an injury and may not be painful.

Alternate Names:
Persistent Penile Erection; Low-Flow or High-Flow Priapism

Prickly Heat

Miliaria, an itchy rash caused by blockage of sweat ducts.

Prick Test

A skin test in which small amounts of suspected allergens are introduced into the skin.

Alternate Names:
Skin-Prick Test; Percutaneous Allergy Test

Primary

First in time, origin, importance, or site; in disease classification it often means arising independently rather than secondary to another cause.

Primary Adrenal Insufficiency

Alternate name; see *Addison Disease*.

Primary Adrenal Lymphoma

A rare lymphoma arising primarily in the adrenal gland, most commonly diffuse large B-cell lymphoma. It often presents bilaterally and may cause adrenal insufficiency.

Primary Aldosteronism

An adrenal disorder in which one or both adrenal glands produce excess aldosterone partly independently of renin–angiotensin regulation. It promotes sodium retention and hypertension while suppressing renin; potassium may be low but is often normal. Common causes include bilateral adrenal hyperplasia and a unilateral aldosterone-producing adenoma.

Primary Alveolar Hypoventilation

A rare disorder of inadequate automatic breathing, often related to PHOX2B or other autonomic-control abnormalities, causing elevated carbon dioxide especially during sleep.

Primary Amebic Meningoencephalitis

A rare, usually fatal infection of the brain caused by the amoeba *Naegleria fowleri*. It occurs when contaminated warm freshwater enters the nose, often during swimming; it is not acquired by drinking the water. Symptoms can include severe headache, fever, stiff neck, confusion, and seizures and progress rapidly.

Alternate Names:
PAM; Naegleriasis; Primary Amoebic Meningoencephalitis; Fatal Amebic Meningoencephalitis

Primary Amenorrhea

No menstrual period by age 15 or within three years after breast development begins. Evaluation may be appropriate earlier if puberty has not begun by age 13. Causes include ovarian, hormonal, genetic, or reproductive-tract conditions.

Alternate Names:
Primary Amenorrhea

Primary Amyloidosis

Primary amyloidosis, usually AL amyloidosis, results from abnormal plasma-cell proteins depositing as amyloid in organs such as the heart, kidneys, nerves, or gastrointestinal tract.

Primary Dysmenorrhea

Recurrent, cramping lower abdominal pain occurring with menstruation in the absence of identifiable pelvic pathology, mediated by excessive uterine prostaglandin release; see *Dysmenorrhea*.

Primary and Secondary Fibrinolysis

The physiologic enzymatic breakdown of fibrin blood clots by plasmin. Primary fibrinolysis occurs without preceding clotting, whereas secondary fibrinoly-

sis is a reactive response to widespread clot formation, as seen in disseminated intravascular coagulation (DIC).

Alternate Names:
Hyperfibrinolysis; Clot Dissolution; Fibrinolytic System

Primary And Secondary Hyperaldosteronism

Excess aldosterone production, from an adrenal source in primary disease or from increased renin stimulation in secondary disease, causing hypertension, sodium retention, and sometimes low potassium.

Primary Angioplasty

Angioplasty used as the initial treatment to reopen an artery during an acute heart attack.

Primary Angle-Closure Glaucoma

A type of glaucoma caused by closure of the anterior-chamber angle, the drainage opening between the iris and cornea. The peripheral iris may block fluid outflow, raising intraocular pressure (pressure inside the eye) and damaging the optic nerve, which carries visual signals to the brain. It may progress slowly or start suddenly with severe eye pain, blurred vision, halos, headache, nausea, or vomiting.

Primary Biliary Cholangitis

A chronic autoimmune liver disease in which small intrahepatic bile ducts are progressively damaged. It can cause cholestasis, itching, fatigue, and eventually cirrhosis; antimitochondrial antibodies often support the diagnosis.

Primary Biliary Cirrhosis

Alternate name; see *Primary Biliary Cholangitis*.

Primary Biliary Cirrhosis (PBC)

Alternate name; see *Primary Biliary Cholangitis*.

Primary Biliary Cirrhosis Treatment

Alternate name; see *Primary Biliary Cholangitis*.

Primary Care

The usual first place people go for healthcare. It includes prevention, check-ups, treatment of common illnesses, care of long-term conditions, basic mental-health support, and referral or coordination with specialists when needed.

Primary Ciliary Dyskinesia

An inherited disorder in which tiny moving hairs lining the airways do not clear mucus properly. It can cause repeated sinus and lung infections, permanent airway widening, hearing problems, infertility, and organs arranged differently from usual.

Primary Ciliary Dyskinesia (Kartagener Syndrome)

An inherited disorder of motile cilia that impairs clearance of airway secretions. It causes chronic wet cough, recurrent sinus and ear disease, bronchiectasis, infertility in some patients, and sometimes situs inversus; long-term airway care and infection prevention are important.

Primary CNS Lymphoma

An aggressive lymphoma confined to the brain, spinal cord, meninges, cerebrospinal fluid, or eyes at diagnosis. It often causes focal neurologic deficits, cognitive change, seizures, or raised intracranial pressure and requires specialist imaging, biopsy, and systemic evaluation.

Primary Cutaneous Amyloidosis

Deposition of amyloid proteins limited mainly to the skin, causing itchy rippled, lichen-like, or darker patches. It differs from systemic amyloidosis, although assessment may be needed when symptoms or findings suggest disease beyond the skin.

Primary Cutaneous B-Cell Lymphoma

A type of lymphoma that starts in the skin and has not spread elsewhere when diagnosed. It may cause one or more painless lumps or plaques; behavior and treatment depend on the subtype.

Primary Endpoint

The main outcome chosen in advance to judge

whether a treatment or other intervention works in a clinical trial. It may be a symptom, laboratory result, complication, quality-of-life measure, or survival.

Primary Hyperaldosteronism

Alternate name; see *Primary Aldosteronism*.

Primary Hyperoxaluria

A group of inherited disorders in which the liver makes too much oxalate. This can cause repeated kidney stones, calcium deposits, kidney damage, and eventually failure of the kidneys.

Primary Hyperparathyroidism

A condition in which one or more parathyroid glands release too much parathyroid hormone, usually causing high blood calcium. It may cause no symptoms or contribute to kidney stones, bone loss, or other problems. Diagnosis uses blood tests; treatment depends on symptoms, calcium level, kidney and bone effects, and overall health.

Alternate Names:
PHPT; Primary Hyperparathyroid Disease; Parathyroid Hyperactivity

Primary Hypersomnia

Excessive daytime sleepiness that is not explained by too little sleep, another sleep disorder, a medicine, substance use, or another illness. It can cause unintended sleep, long sleep, and difficulty becoming fully alert after waking.

Primary Hypertension

Persistently high blood pressure without one identifiable underlying disease. It results from a combination of genetic, environmental, vascular, and lifestyle factors and can often be controlled with lifestyle changes and medicines.

Primary Hypertrophic Osteoarthropathy

A rare inherited condition causing enlarged, rounded fingertips, thickened facial or scalp skin, and new bone growth along the limbs. It may cause joint pain, stiffness, swelling, and excessive sweating.

Primary Hypoparathyroidism

Inadequate parathyroid hormone production causing low calcium and high phosphate, with possible tingling, cramps, tetany, seizures, cataracts, or chronic bone and dental effects.

Primary Hypothyroidism

Reduced thyroid-gland production of thyroxine and triiodothyronine, usually causing high TSH and symptoms such as fatigue, cold intolerance, constipation, dry skin, and slowed heart rate.

Primary Immune Response

The body's first targeted immune response to a new germ or other foreign substance. It develops over days, produces antibodies and immune cells, and creates memory that allows a faster response next time.

Primary Immunodeficiency

A group of usually inherited disorders in which part of the immune system is missing or does not work properly. They can cause repeated or unusually severe infections and may also cause autoimmune disease or inflammation.

Primary Immunodeficiency Disease

An inherited or genetic disorder of immune development or function that causes unusual, recurrent, severe, or persistent infections and sometimes autoimmunity.

Primary Immunodeficiency Disease PIDD

Primary immunodeficiency diseases are inherited disorders of immune development or function that cause unusual, severe, recurrent, or persistent infections and sometimes autoimmunity or inflammation. Evaluation may include blood counts, immunoglobulins, functional tests, and genetic testing.

Alternate Names:
PID; Inborn Errors of Immunity; IEI

Primary Lactase Deficiency

Reduced lactase enzyme activity developing with age, causing lactose malabsorption and possible

bloating, abdominal pain, gas, or diarrhea after dairy consumption.

Primary Lateral Sclerosis

A rare progressive nerve disorder causing increasing muscle stiffness and weakness, usually beginning in the legs. Speech, swallowing, walking, and emotional control may become affected over time.

Primary Lymphoid Organs

The bone marrow and thymus, where lymphocytes are made and mature.

Primary Lymphoma Of The Brain

Primary central-nervous-system lymphoma is a lymphoma arising in the brain, spinal cord, eyes, or surrounding fluid without systemic disease at diagnosis.

Primary Metabolism

The essential chemical activity inside cells that produces energy, builds needed substances, breaks down waste, and keeps cells alive and functioning.

Primary Microrna

The first RNA copy made from a microRNA gene. It is processed inside and outside the cell nucleus into a shorter molecule that helps control which proteins cells make.

Primary Myelofibrosis

A long-term bone-marrow disorder in which scar tissue replaces healthy marrow. Blood-cell production may move to the spleen or liver, causing anemia, tiredness, easy bleeding or infection, bone pain, and an enlarged spleen.

Alternate Names:
Agnogenic Myeloid Metaplasia

Primary Open-Angle Glaucoma

A usually slowly progressive optic neuropathy (disease of the optic nerve) in which the anterior-chamber angle, where fluid drains, remains open. It often has no early symptoms, and peripheral (side) vision may be affected first. Intraocular pressure (pressure inside the eye) is often elevated, but optic-nerve damage can also occur at statistically normal pressure levels.

Primary Osteoporosis

Weakening and thinning of bone caused mainly by aging, loss of estrogen after menopause, or age-related changes, rather than by another disease or medicine. It increases the risk of fractures, especially in the hip, spine, and wrist.

Primary Ovarian Insufficiency

Loss of normal ovarian activity before age 40, characterized by irregular or absent menses, reduced estrogen, and intermittently or persistently elevated gonadotropins. Causes include genetic, autoimmune, iatrogenic, toxic, infectious, and unknown factors.

Primary Polycythemia

Alternate name; see *Polycythemia Vera*.

Primary Prevention

Actions taken before a disease begins to prevent it, such as vaccination, avoiding tobacco, reducing harmful exposures, using sun protection, and controlling health risks. It differs from screening, which looks for disease that may already be present.

Primary Progressive Aphasia

A neurodegenerative disorder causing gradual worsening of language abilities, including speaking, naming, comprehension, reading, or writing.

Primary Progressive Multiple Sclerosis

A form of multiple sclerosis that gradually worsens from the beginning, without clear attacks and recoveries. It commonly affects walking, strength, balance, bladder control, and thinking; medicines and rehabilitation may slow disability.

Alternate Names:
PPMS; Primary Progressive MS

Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis

A long-term disease in which inflammation and scarring narrow the bile tubes inside and outside the

liver. It can cause itching, tiredness, jaundice, repeated infections, and liver damage and is often associated with inflammatory bowel disease.

Primary Spinal Bone Tumor

A rare tumor that starts in a bone of the spine rather than spreading there from another organ. It may be benign or cancerous. A growing tumor can cause lasting back pain, weaken a vertebra, or press on the spinal cord or nearby nerves.

Primary Systemic Amyloidosis

A form of AL amyloidosis in which abnormal immunoglobulin light chains made by a plasma-cell clone deposit in organs such as the heart, kidneys, nerves, liver, or gastrointestinal tract. Symptoms depend on the organs involved and require hematology evaluation.

Primary Tuberculosis

The first infection with the bacterium that causes tuberculosis. It often begins in the lungs and nearby lymph nodes; the immune system may contain it without symptoms, or it may progress to active disease.

Primary Tumor

The original tumor, or site where a cancer began, from which cancer cells may spread to form secondary or metastatic tumors. A cancer may be described as having an unknown primary when the original site cannot be identified.

Primary Vulvar Clear Cell Adenocarcinoma

A rare cancer of the vulva made up of clear-looking cells. Diagnosis requires examination of a tissue sample and tests that distinguish it from cancer that has spread from the kidney or another organ.

Primidone

Primidone is an antiseizure medicine used for epilepsy and sometimes essential tremor; it can cause sleepiness, dizziness, and drug interactions.

Primigravida

A person who is pregnant for the first time. First pregnancies may have a longer labor and require monitoring for conditions such as high blood pressure, but the term itself does not indicate a problem.

Primipara

A person who has given birth once after the fetus could survive outside the womb, regardless of outcome.

Primitive

Relating to an early developmental stage or a basic, less specialized form. In medicine, primitive cells may be immature and capable of developing into several more specialized cell types.

Primitive Node

The primitive node is an embryonic organizer at the cranial end of the primitive streak that helps establish body axes and germ-layer formation.

Primitive Streak

The primitive streak is an embryonic structure through which cells migrate during gastrulation to form the three germ layers and establish body organization.

Primordial

Present at the earliest stage of development or existing in an original, basic form. Examples include primordial germ cells and primordial follicles.

Primordial Prevention

Preventing the emergence of disease risk factors by addressing social, economic, behavioural, and environmental conditions early. Examples: promoting healthy diets and physical activity in children, reducing tobacco exposure, and creating safe environments for exercise.

PR Interval

The ECG interval from the start of atrial depolarization to the start of ventricular depolarization, reflecting atrioventricular conduction.

Prinzmetal Angina

Episodes of chest pain caused by a temporary spasm, or tightening, of a heart artery. The pain often occurs at rest and may happen when fixed fatty plaque is not blocking the artery. Also called vasospastic or variant angina.

Alternate Names:
Vasospastic Angina; Variant Angina

Prion

An infectious protein folded into an abnormal shape that can make other proteins fold incorrectly. Prions cause rare, serious brain diseases that worsen over time; they are not ordinary bacteria or viruses and currently have no cure.

Prion Disease

A group of rare, rapidly progressive, and fatal neurodegenerative brain disorders caused by prions—abnormal, misfolded forms of a naturally occurring cellular protein. When a prion enters the brain or misfolds spontaneously, it forces surrounding normal proteins into the same distorted shape, causing clumps of defective proteins to destroy brain tissue and create microscopic sponge-like holes. Prion diseases can arise spontaneously (as in sporadic Creutzfeldt–Jakob disease), be inherited through genetic mutations, or rarely be transmitted through exposure to infected brain or nervous tissue. They cause rapidly worsening memory loss, dementia, loss of balance and motor coordination, and involuntary muscle jerks.

Alternate Names:
Prion Diseases; Transmissible Spongiform Encephalopathies; TSE; Prion Disorders

Prism

A clear optical device that bends light. In eye care, prisms can measure or correct eye misalignment, reduce double vision, and be built into glasses or used during examinations.

Privacy

Privacy is a person's right and expectation that personal information, communications, and bodily matters are protected from unauthorized access or disclosure.

Privacy Breach

A privacy breach is unauthorized access, use, disclosure, loss, or exposure of personal or health information.

Private Mutation

A genetic variant confined to a family, individual, tumor, or small population rather than commonly seen in the general population; its significance requires genetic and clinical interpretation.

PRK

Photorefractive keratectomy is laser eye surgery that reshapes the cornea to reduce short-sightedness, long-sightedness, or astigmatism. The surface layer is removed and grows back during healing; pain, haze, infection, or imperfect vision can occur.

Probe

A blunt instrument used to examine an opening, cavity, wound, tooth, or narrow passage. Different probes can measure depth, check whether a passage is open, guide a procedure, or trace a sinus or fistula.

Probenecid

A uricosuric medicine used to prevent gout attacks in selected patients and to alter renal excretion of some drugs.

Probiotic

A viable, non-pathogenic live microorganism (predominantly strains of *Lactobacillus*, *Bifidobacterium*, or *Saccharomyces boulardii*) that, when administered in adequate amounts, confers a health benefit on the host by colonizing and restoring microbial equilibrium to the gastrointestinal microbiota, inhibiting enteric pathogens, and modulating local mucosal immunity.

Alternate Names:
Probiotics

Probiotics

Plural form; see *Probiotic*.

Probucol

Probucol is a lipid-lowering drug that reduces cholesterol but may prolong the QT interval and is not widely used in current practice.

PROC

PROC is the gene symbol for protein C, an anticoagulant protein that limits clot formation; inherited deficiency increases thrombosis risk.

Procainamide

An antiarrhythmic medicine that can slow abnormal electrical conduction in the heart. It is used in selected rhythm disorders and requires monitoring because it can affect blood pressure, the heart rhythm, and immune or blood systems.

Procaine

An ester local anesthetic that temporarily blocks nerve signals and reduces pain. It is now used mainly in limited or historical settings because newer anesthetics are commonly preferred and allergic reactions can occur.

Procalcitonin

A biomarker that may rise during some bacterial infections and systemic inflammation. It can support assessment of infection and antibiotic decisions, but it cannot by itself diagnose or exclude bacterial infection or determine sepsis severity.

Procalcitonin Test

A blood biomarker test measuring procalcitonin, a peptide whose levels rise in response to severe systemic bacterial infections and sepsis; see *Procalcitonin*.

Procarbazine

A chemotherapy medicine used in some lymphomas and brain tumors. It damages the DNA of rapidly growing cells and can cause nausea, low blood counts, infertility, or other side effects; alcohol and many medicines may interact with it.

Procarbazine Hydrochloride

A salt form of procarbazine, a chemotherapy medicine that damages cancer cells. It is used for selected lymphomas and brain tumors and can cause low blood counts, nausea, infertility, or serious medicine and food interactions.

Procedural Memory

Memory for how to perform learned skills, such as riding a bicycle, typing, or playing an instrument. It usually works without consciously recalling each step and differs from memory for facts or events.

Procedural Sedation

Use of medicines to reduce anxiety, discomfort, and awareness during a medical procedure while maintaining breathing and protective reflexes. Continuous monitoring is required because sedation can unexpectedly become deeper and slow breathing.

Procedure

A planned medical or surgical action performed to diagnose, treat, prevent, monitor, or relieve a health problem. It may involve an examination, sample collection, medicine delivery, device placement, or operation, with risks depending on the method and person.

Alternate Names:
Medical Procedure; Clinical Procedure; Intervention

Procentriole

An immature structure that forms next to an existing centriole as a cell prepares to divide. It later matures into a centriole, which helps organize the fibers that separate chromosomes.

Procerus Muscle

A small facial muscle over the bridge of the nose that draws the medial eyebrows downward and produces horizontal wrinkles between the eyebrows.

Process

A process is an ordered series of biological, physical, chemical, or operational changes that produces a result.

Processing Bodies

Processing bodies are cytoplasmic RNA-protein granules where messenger RNAs may be stored, decapped, degraded, or regulated.

Prochlorperazine

A phenothiazine medicine used mainly for severe nausea or vomiting and, in selected cases, psychotic disorders. It can cause drowsiness, low blood pressure, and movement disorders.

Prochlorperazine Overdose

An excessive amount of prochlorperazine can cause severe sleepiness, confusion, low blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, seizures, or muscle stiffness with fever.

Procidentia

The most severe form of uterine prolapse, in which the uterus and cervix descend through and outside the vaginal opening. It may cause pressure, bleeding, sores, difficulty urinating, or bowel problems and requires gynecologic assessment.

Alternate Names:
Complete Uterovaginal Prolapse; Third-Degree Uterine Prolapse

Procollagen

An unfinished form of collagen made inside cells. After chemical changes and removal of its end sections outside the cell, it joins with other molecules to form strong collagen fibers in skin, bone, tendons, and other tissues.

Proctalgia

Pain in or around the rectum or anal canal. Causes include fissures, hemorrhoids, abscesses, inflammation, injury, and functional muscle pain; sudden severe pain or pain with fever, bleeding, or a lump can indicate significant disease.

Proctalgia Fugax

A benign functional anorectal disorder characterized by sudden, severe, fleeting, cramp-like spasms of intense pain localized to the rectum and anus lasting from seconds to several minutes (maximum 30 minutes) and resolving completely, occurring predominantly at night due to levator ani and anal sphincter spasm.

Alternate Names:
Fugacious Rectal Pain; Nocturnal Rectal Spasm

Proctitis

Inflammation of the rectum. It can cause a constant urge to pass stool, rectal pain, bleeding, mucus or pus, and pelvic discomfort. Causes include inflammatory bowel disease, sexually transmitted infections, radiation treatment, and diversion of stool through an opening in the abdomen. Diagnosis may require an examination, stool or swab tests, and a small tissue sample. Treatment depends on the cause.

Alternate Names:
Rectal Inflammation

Proctocolitis

Inflammation of the rectum and nearby lower colon. It may cause bleeding, mucus, diarrhea, urgency, pain, or difficulty passing stool and can result from infection, inflammatory bowel disease, reduced blood flow, radiation, or other causes.

Proctology

The part of medicine concerned with diseases of the anus and rectum. Care may include assessment and treatment of hemorrhoids, fissures, fistulas, abscesses, bowel-control problems, infections, inflammation, and cancers.

Proctoscope

An instrument used to inspect the anal canal and rectum.

Proctoscopy

Examination of the anal canal and rectum with a short viewing instrument. It can help investigate bleeding, pain, inflammation, ulcers, polyps, or a lump and may allow a small tissue sample to be taken.

Proctostomy

An operation that creates an opening from the rectum through the abdominal wall or nearby skin so stool can leave the body. It may be temporary or permanent and requires care of the opening and surrounding skin.

Prodromal

Describing early, nonspecific signs or symptoms that occur before the characteristic clinical features of a disease become apparent.

Prodrome

An early symptom or group of symptoms that appears before a disease episode or major event. Examples include tiredness before migraine, tingling before a seizure, or fever before an infection becomes obvious.

Prodrug

A medicine given in a form that the body changes into its active form. This design may improve absorption, delivery to a target tissue, duration of action, or tolerability.

Productive Cough

A cough that brings up mucus or phlegm from the airways. It can occur with infections, asthma, chronic lung disease, or other conditions and does not by itself identify the cause.

Profunda

A deep artery or vessel, commonly referring to the profunda femoris artery in the thigh. This artery supplies muscles and nearby tissues and can be important in bleeding, circulation, or vascular procedures.

Progenitor

A partly developed cell that can multiply and mature into one or a limited range of specialized cell types. Progenitor cells help replace or repair tissues but have less developmental potential than stem cells.

Progeny

Biological offspring or descendants. In genetics, the term usually means children or later descendants whose traits may be studied to understand how characteristics or disorders are inherited. In cell biology, it can mean daughter cells produced by one parent cell.

Progeria

A rare genetic disorder in which features resembling accelerated aging begin during childhood. The usual form is Hutchinson–Gilford progeria syndrome, caused by a disease-causing variant in the *LMNA* gene that produces abnormal lamin A. Most cases result from a new variant rather than inheritance from an affected parent. Children are often healthy-looking at birth and later develop slowed growth, loss of body fat, hair loss, thin aged-looking skin, joint stiffness, and characteristic facial features. Accelerated atherosclerosis can cause early cardiovascular disease, while intellectual development is usually preserved.

Alternate Names:
Hutchinson–Gilford Progeria Syndrome Hutchinson–Gilford Syndrome HGPS

Progestational

Relating to progesterone-like effects or preparation of the uterus for pregnancy. Progestational medicines can alter menstrual bleeding, prevent ovulation, support the uterine lining, or protect it from excessive estrogen stimulation.

Progesterone

A steroid hormone produced mainly by the corpus luteum and placenta that supports the endometrium and pregnancy.

Progesterone Antagonist

A progesterone antagonist blocks progesterone receptors and may be used for selected reproductive, gynecologic, or other medical purposes.

Progesterone Receptor

A protein inside or on a cell that binds progesterone. Some breast cancers have these receptors, which

helps describe the cancer's biology.

Progesterone Supplementation

Use of progesterone during pregnancy in selected people at risk of preterm birth, especially when ultrasound shows a short cervix. Vaginal progesterone may be considered in that situation; routine use after a previous preterm birth without a short cervix is not recommended, and 17-hydroxyprogesterone caproate is no longer FDA-approved for this purpose.

Progesterone Test

A blood test that measures the level of progesterone, a hormone involved in ovulation and pregnancy. It may help assess ovulation, infertility, abnormal uterine bleeding, fertility treatment, or certain pregnancy problems. Results depend on the timing of the menstrual cycle and whether the person is pregnant.

Alternate Names:
Serum Progesterone Progesterone Blood Test

Progestin

A progestin is a synthetic progesterone-like hormone used in contraception, hormone therapy, and treatment of selected gynecologic conditions.

Progestogen

A natural or synthetic hormone with effects like progesterone. Progestogens help regulate the menstrual cycle and pregnancy and are used in some contraceptives and hormone treatments.

Progestogen-Only Pill

Oral contraceptive tablets formulated solely with a progestin without an estrogen component. They prevent conception primarily by thickening cervical mucus to impede sperm penetration, altering endometrial receptivity, and in certain formulations inhibiting the mid-cycle luteinizing hormone surge.

Alternate Names:
Progestin-Only Pill; POP; Mini-Pill

Proglottid

One segment of a tapeworm. Each mature segment contains reproductive organs and may release eggs in stool.

Prognathism

Forward projection of the upper or lower jaw relative to the facial skeleton, affecting bite, appearance, chewing, speech, and sometimes airway function.

Prognosis

The expected course and outcome of a disease or condition.

Prognostic Factor

A prognostic factor is a clinical, pathologic, or biologic feature associated with the likely course, outcome, or survival of a disease.

Prognostic Test

A test that provides information about a disease's likely course or outcome. Results may estimate risks, guide treatment choices, or monitor response, but they cannot predict an individual future with certainty.

Programmed Cell Death

A controlled process by which cells die as part of normal development, tissue maintenance, or disease. Apoptosis is the best-known form; other regulated forms include necroptosis and pyroptosis.

Progression

Worsening or advancement of a disease, such as increasing tumor size, new lesions, or spread to another site.

Progression-Free Survival

The length of time after a defined starting point, such as diagnosis or treatment, during which a person remains alive without the cancer worsening. It is a group measure used in research and cannot predict exactly what will happen to one person.

Progressive

Increasing, worsening, or spreading over time, or moving forward in a particular direction. A progressive disease may cause gradually increasing symptoms, but the word alone does not explain the cause, speed, or expected outcome.

Progressive Disease

A disease that is worsening, spreading, or becoming more active over time. In cancer, progression may mean that tumors have grown, new tumors have appeared, or existing disease has clearly worsened on examination or imaging.

Progressive Lenticular Degeneration

An older name for Wilson disease, an inherited disorder causing copper buildup. Excess copper can damage the liver, brain, eyes, kidneys, and other organs unless treatment lowers copper levels.

Progressive Multifocal Leukoencephalopathy

A serious brain infection caused by reactivation of JC virus in people with severely weakened immune systems. It damages the brain's nerve insulation and may cause worsening weakness, clumsiness, vision or speech problems, confusion, or seizures.

Progressive Muscular Atrophy

A motor-neuron disorder predominantly affecting lower motor neurons and causing progressive muscle wasting and weakness.

Progressive Supranuclear Palsy

A progressive brain disorder that causes balance problems, frequent falls, stiffness, slowed movement, speech or swallowing difficulty, and trouble moving the eyes, especially looking down. It resembles Parkinson disease but has different features and treatment needs.

Alternate Names:
Steele-Richardson-Olszewski Syndrome Supranuclear Palsy

Proinflammatory

Describing a substance, cell, or immune response that starts or increases inflammation. Such activity can help fight infection or repair injury, but excessive or prolonged inflammation can damage healthy tissue.

Proinsulin

An unfinished hormone made by pancreatic beta cells before it is split into insulin and C-peptide. Measuring proinsulin can provide information about insulin production and certain disorders of glucose regulation.

Projectile Vomiting

Forceful vomiting expelled with unusual intensity, which may occur with gastric outlet obstruction, raised intracranial pressure, infection, migraine, or other causes; severity and associated signs guide evaluation.

Projection

A view or image made by directing X-rays or other imaging energy through the body toward a detector. Different projections show body structures from different angles and can help locate an abnormality.

Prokaryote

A prokaryote is a cell or organism without a membrane-bound nucleus, including bacteria and archaea.

Prokinetic

A medicine that promotes gastrointestinal motility and movement of contents through the digestive tract; use depends on the underlying disorder and safety profile.

Prolactin

A hormone released mainly by the pituitary gland that supports breast development and milk production. Abnormal levels can affect periods, fertility, sexual function, pregnancy, breastfeeding, and sometimes vision because of pituitary growths.

Prolactin Blood Test

A prolactin blood test measures the hormone prolactin and helps evaluate abnormal milk production, menstrual or fertility problems, and some pituitary disorders.

Prolactin Deficiency

Inadequate production of prolactin by the pituitary, most clearly recognized by failure to produce breast milk after delivery. It may occur with broader pituitary disease, surgery, hemorrhage, or injury and is evaluated with other pituitary hormones.

Prolactinoma

A benign, non-cancerous tumor of the pituitary gland that produces excessive amounts of prolactin, the hormone that stimulates breast milk production. Elevated prolactin levels can disrupt normal reproductive hormones, causing irregular or absent menstrual periods, unexpected breast milk production (galactorrhea), and infertility in women, or reduced sex drive and erectile dysfunction in men, as well as headaches or vision changes if the tumor grows large.

Alternate Names:
Prolactin-Secreting Adenoma; Lactotroph Adenoma

Prolactinoma Treatment

Treatment may include a dopamine agonist, surgery, radiation, or observation, depending on tumor size, symptoms, hormone levels, treatment response, and patient preferences. Dopamine agonists often lower prolactin levels and reduce tumor size.

Prolactin Physiology

Prolactin is a hormone made by the pituitary gland that supports breast development and milk production. Levels normally rise during pregnancy, breastfeeding, sleep, stress, and breast stimulation.

Prolactin Receptor

A cell-surface receptor activated by prolactin to regulate mammary development, milk production, reproduction, immune effects, and other tissue responses.

Prolapse

Downward displacement or protrusion of an organ or tissue from its normal position, often through a supporting structure or body opening.

Prolapsed Bladder

Alternate name; see *Anterior Vaginal Prolapse*.

Prolapsed Cord

A prolapsed umbilical cord descends beside or ahead of the fetus after membrane rupture, risking cord compression and reduced fetal oxygen; it is an obstetric emergency.

Prolapsed Disk

A spinal disk that bulges or ruptures and may compress a nearby nerve; also called a herniated disk.

Alternate Names:
Herniated Nucleus Pulposus; Slipped Disc; Herniated Disc

Prolapsed Uterus

Alternate name; see *Uterine Prolapse*.

Prolapse Of Orbital Fat

Bulging of the eye's normal cushioning fat through a weak spot in the thin tissue around the eye. It usually appears as a soft, painless lump in an upper or lower eyelid, often with aging, but other lumps may look similar.

Proliferating Pilar Tumor

A usually low-grade follicular tumor arising from a trichilemmal cyst, most often on the scalp. It may be large, ulcerated, recurrent, or locally aggressive, so complete excision and histologic assessment are important.

Proliferating Trichilemmal Tumor

A usually low-grade follicular tumor arising from a trichilemmal cyst, most often on the scalp; large or recurrent lesions may show locally aggressive or malignant behavior.

Proliferation

Increase in the number of cells or organisms through growth and division. It may be normal, part of healing, or abnormal as in uncontrolled tumor growth.

Proliferative

Characterized by increased cell multiplication or new tissue growth. The meaning depends on context: some proliferative changes are normal or healing, while others are precancerous or cancerous.

Proliferative Diabetic Retinopathy

An advanced form of diabetic eye disease in which poor blood supply causes fragile new blood vessels to grow on the retina or nearby structures. They can bleed, scar, detach the retina, and threaten vision; specialist treatment can reduce these risks.

Proliferative Fasciitis

A benign, reactive fibroblastic proliferation resembling nodular fasciitis but containing distinctive ganglion-like cells; it usually grows quickly and resolves or stabilizes after local treatment.

Proliferative Myositis

A benign reactive proliferation within skeletal muscle that may present as a rapidly enlarging mass and mimic sarcoma. Imaging and biopsy are used to establish the diagnosis.

Proliferative Retinopathy

Advanced retinal disease in which abnormal new blood vessels grow and may bleed or impair vision.

Proline

An amino acid used to build proteins. Its ring-shaped side chain helps give collagen and other proteins their structure.

Prolonged Capillary Refill Time

A delay of greater than two to three seconds for normal skin color to return after moderate digital blanching pressure is applied to a distal nail bed or pulp and released. It is a bedside indicator of reduced peripheral microvascular perfusion, shock, dehydration, or hypothermia.

Prolonged Deceleration

A temporary slowing of the fetal heart rate lasting at least two minutes but less than ten minutes. It may result from reduced blood flow, excessive contractions, cord problems, or placental separation and can indicate fetal compromise.

Prolonged Grief Disorder

A bereavement-related condition characterized by severe, disabling, and persistent yearning or preoccupation with a deceased loved one lasting at least 12 months after the loss; see *Complicated Grief*.

Prolonged Labor

Abnormally protracted or arrested progress of labor during the active cervical dilation or fetal expulsion phase; see *Labor Dystocia*.

Prolonged Second Stage

The pushing stage of labor lasting longer than expected. The safe duration depends on whether it is a first birth, use of epidural anesthesia, progress, and the health of the parent and fetus; the team reassesses before deciding on further care.

Prolymphocyte Count

The number or proportion of prolymphocytes, immature-appearing lymphoid cells, in blood or marrow; an increased count may occur in selected lymphoid leukemias and requires morphology and immunophenotyping.

Prolymphocytic Leukemia

Prolymphocytic leukemia is a rare aggressive leukemia with large abnormal lymphocytes in the blood, bone marrow, spleen, or lymph nodes.

Promazine

A first-generation phenothiazine antipsychotic with sedative properties; it is now used infrequently in many settings and availability varies by country. It can cause drowsiness, orthostatic hypotension, anticholinergic effects, extrapyramidal symptoms,

and other serious antipsychotic adverse effects.

Promecarb

Promecarb is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause cholinergic poisoning after substantial exposure.

Prometaphase

Prometaphase is the stage of mitosis after nuclear-envelope breakdown when spindle microtubules attach to chromosome kinetochores.

Promethazine

Promethazine is an antihistamine used for allergy symptoms, nausea, motion sickness, and sometimes sedation; it can cause marked sleepiness and breathing problems in young children.

Promethazine Overdose

An excessive amount of promethazine can cause extreme drowsiness, confusion, agitation, fast heartbeat, seizures, breathing problems, or coma. Children are particularly vulnerable.

Prominent Iris Collarette

A visible thickening or ridge of the iris at the junction of the pupillary and ciliary zones, representing the site where the embryonic pupillary membrane was attached. It is typically a normal anatomical variant but can be a clinical sign in conditions such as Axenfeld-Rieger syndrome or iridocorneal endothelial syndrome.

Promonocyte Count

The number or proportion of promonocytes, immature monocyte precursors, in blood or marrow; increased cells may support evaluation of acute or chronic myeloid leukemia.

Promontory

A part of the body that projects outward like a small ridge or bump. Examples include the sacral promontory in the pelvis and the cochlear promontory in the inner ear; the exact meaning depends on the structure named.

Promoter

A specific nucleotide sequence located upstream of a gene that serves as the binding site for RNA polymerase and associated transcription factors, thereby dictating the initiation, orientation, and level of gene transcription.

Alternate Names:
Promoters; Gene Promoter

Promoters

Plural form; see *Promoter*.

Promyelocytes

Immature cells in the bone-marrow pathway that normally develops into several types of white blood cells. Large numbers in blood or marrow may occur in leukemia and need examination with other blood and cell tests.

Pronation

Turning the forearm so the palm faces down when the elbow is bent, or backward when the arm hangs at the side. During this movement, the radius rotates across the ulna.

Pronator

A muscle that turns a limb or part of it into a pronated position. In the forearm, pronator muscles rotate the palm downward and help stabilize the elbow during movement.

Pronator Drift

A subtle test for nerve or brain weakness where holding the arms straight out with palms up and eyes closed causes one hand to turn inward and slowly drift down.

Prone

Position in which a person lies face down, with the front of the body toward the supporting surface. The term describes body orientation; the head may be turned to either side, and the body may be tilted during a procedure.

Pronephric

Relating to the earliest temporary kidney system formed in an embryo. In humans it does not provide effective kidney function and is replaced during development by later kidney structures.

Pronephros

The first temporary kidney structure formed in a human embryo. It is not functional as a kidney and largely disappears as the permanent kidneys develop.

Prone Position

Alternate name; see *Prone*.

Prone Positioning

Placing a person face down to improve breathing, especially during severe acute respiratory distress syndrome. It can improve oxygen levels by helping more of the lung take part in breathing, but requires careful monitoring of the airway, skin, eyes, and pressure points.

Propafenone

A heart-rhythm medicine that slows electrical signals through the heart. It is used for selected irregular rhythms, including episodes of atrial fibrillation, but can worsen or cause dangerous rhythms and is unsuitable for some people with structural heart disease.

Propane

Propane is a flammable hydrocarbon gas used as fuel; inhalation or displacement of oxygen can cause suffocation, and liquid contact can cause cold burns.

Propane Poisoning

Breathing concentrated propane can displace oxygen and cause dizziness, headache, confusion, unconsciousness, abnormal heart rhythms, or suffocation. Propane is highly flammable and can form explosive mixtures with air.

Propanol

Propanol is an alcohol solvent with two structural isomers; ingestion or substantial exposure can depress the nervous system and irritate tissues.

Propanolol

A nonselective beta-adrenergic blocker used for hypertension, arrhythmias, angina, tremor, migraine prevention, and other indications.

Propantheline

An older medicine that reduces certain nerve signals to relax the gut and decrease sweating. It can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, difficulty urinating, fast heartbeat, or confusion and is rarely used today.

Propellant

A propellant is a gas or volatile substance that expels a product from a container or delivers medicine in an inhaler.

Properdin

A blood protein that strengthens one part of the body's early immune defense. It helps mark and damage certain germs; too little properdin can increase susceptibility to serious bacterial infections.

Properdin Deficiency

A rare inherited immune-system disorder in which a complement protein is missing or low. It increases the risk of severe infections, especially meningococcal disease, and is evaluated with immune tests and a history of recurrent infections.

Propetamphos

Propetamphos is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

Prophage

A prophage is bacteriophage genetic material integrated into a bacterial chromosome or maintained in a dormant state inside a bacterium.

Prophase

Prophase is the early stage of cell division when

chromosomes condense, the spindle begins forming, and the nucleolus disappears.

Prophenofos

Prophenofos is an organophosphate pesticide whose toxicity results mainly from acetylcholinesterase inhibition and excess cholinergic activity.

Prophylactic

Prophylactic means intended to prevent disease, infection, injury, or another unwanted outcome before it occurs.

Prophylactic Mastectomy

Prophylactic mastectomy removes one or both breasts to greatly reduce cancer risk in selected people at very high genetic or clinical risk.

Prophylaxis

Medicine or other preventive care used to lower risk of disease, infection, or recurrence before it occurs.

Propionates

Salts or esters of propionic acid used in food preservation, metabolism, and some medicines; clinical effects depend on the specific compound and exposure.

Propionibacterium

A former bacterial genus name now largely replaced by Cutibacterium; its members are common skin organisms and can cause acne or device-related infection.

Propionic Acidemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot properly break down certain proteins and fats. Harmful acids can build up, especially during illness or fasting, causing vomiting, extreme sleepiness, poor feeding, seizures, or coma. Newborn screening can detect it; treatment uses a controlled diet, avoids fasting, and manages attacks urgently.

Alternate Names:
Propionic Aciduria (PA); Propionyl-CoA Carboxylase Deficiency

Propofol

A short-acting medicine given through a vein to start or maintain anesthesia and provide procedural sedation. It acts quickly but can lower blood pressure, slow breathing, or cause dangerous reactions without monitoring.

Propofol Infusion Syndrome

A rare, potentially fatal illness after prolonged or high-dose propofol infusion. It may cause severe blood acidity, muscle breakdown, high potassium, kidney failure, heart failure, or dangerous heart rhythms. Stopping propofol and urgent intensive care are required when it is suspected.

Propoxur

Propoxur is a carbamate insecticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and may cause sweating, salivation, vomiting, breathing difficulty, or weakness after exposure.

Propoxycaine

A local anesthetic formerly used in some topical or dental preparations; toxicity can affect the nervous system and heart.

Propoxyphene

Propoxyphene is a former opioid analgesic withdrawn in many countries because of overdose toxicity, respiratory depression, and dangerous cardiac arrhythmias.

Propranolol

A beta-blocking medicine that slows heart rate and reduces the body's response to adrenaline. It treats selected heart conditions, tremor, migraine prevention, anxiety symptoms, and other problems, but can worsen asthma or low blood sugar.

Proprioception

Awareness of body position and movement without looking, based on signals from muscles, tendons, joints, skin, and balance organs. Reduced proprioception can cause clumsiness, poor coordination, falls, or difficulty walking.

Proprioceptor

A sensory receptor that detects position, movement, or muscle stretch.

Proptosis

The abnormal forward protrusion or displacement of one or both eyeballs from the orbit. Major causes include thyroid eye disease (Graves ophthalmopathy), orbital cellulitis, orbital tumors, idiopathic orbital inflammation, and vascular malformations such as carotid-cavernous fistulas.

Alternate Names:
Exophthalmos; Ocular Proptosis; Proptosis of Eye; Bulging Eyes

Proptosis of Eye

Alternate name; see *Proptosis*.

Propulsion

Movement that drives the body or another object forward. In some neurologic disorders, impaired forward movement can cause short, shuffling steps or a tendency to lean and fall forward.

Propyl Alcohol

Propyl alcohols are flammable solvents; ingestion or substantial exposure can irritate tissues and depress the central nervous system, with toxicity depending on the isomer and dose.

Propylene Glycol

Propylene glycol is a solvent and humectant used in medicines, foods, and cosmetics; large exposures can cause metabolic or kidney problems.

Propylthiouracil

Propylthiouracil is an antithyroid drug that reduces thyroid-hormone synthesis and conversion of T4 to T3; liver injury and fetal risks require careful use.

Pro Re Nata

A medication or treatment instruction meaning that it should be used only when a specified symptom or clinical circumstance occurs, within clearly prescribed dose and frequency limits.

Alternate Names:
PRN; As Needed

Prosencephalon

The front part of the early developing brain. It later forms the cerebral hemispheres, thalamus, hypothalamus, and related structures that control thought, sensation, movement, hormones, and other functions.

Prosopagnosia

Difficulty or inability to recognize familiar faces despite adequate vision and general intelligence. It may be developmental or result from brain injury or disease.

Prosoplasia

Development of a more specialized cell function or structure within a tissue. The change may occur during normal development or as an adaptation, and its medical meaning depends on the tissue and surrounding disease process.

Prosoposchisis

A rare congenital facial cleft or fissure caused by abnormal fusion of facial processes during embryonic development, potentially affecting the nose, mouth, eyes, and feeding or breathing.

Prostacyclin Analogs

Medications that mimic prostacyclin (PGI2), causing vasodilation and inhibiting platelet aggregation in the pulmonary vasculature. They include epoprostenol (continuous IV), treprostinil (subcutaneous, IV, inhaled, oral), and iloprost (inhaled). They are used for severe PAH.

Prostaglandin

An autocrine and paracrine bioactive lipid mediator synthesized from membrane arachidonic acid via the cyclooxygenase (COX-1 and COX-2) pathway. Major prostaglandins include PGE_2, $PGF_{2\alpha}$, PGD_2, and PGI_2 (prostacyclin), which regulate inflammatory responses, nociception, body temperature, platelet aggregation, vascular tone, renal blood flow, cytoprotection of the gastric mucosa, and uterine

smooth muscle contraction during labor.

Alternate Names:
Prostaglandins

Prostaglandin Analogs

Eye-drop medicines that lower pressure inside the eye by helping fluid drain. They treat glaucoma or ocular hypertension and may cause eye redness, eyelash growth, or darkening of the iris or skin around the eye.

Prostaglandin Degradation

Enzymatic inactivation and removal of prostaglandins, which limits the duration and intensity of their local effects on vessels, inflammation, smooth muscle, kidneys, stomach, and reproductive tissues.

Prostaglandin E2

A prostaglandin that mediates inflammation, pain, fever, vasodilation, gastric protection, cervical ripening, and uterine contraction and is used in selected obstetric and cardiovascular treatments.

Prostaglandin F2-Alpha

A prostaglandin that promotes smooth-muscle contraction and luteolysis; analogues are used in glaucoma, postpartum hemorrhage, labor-related care, and veterinary medicine.

Prostaglandin Receptor

A protein on or inside a cell that recognizes a prostaglandin and starts signals affecting blood-vessel width, inflammation, pain, smooth-muscle activity, platelets, or reproduction.

Prostaglandins

Plural form; see *Prostaglandin*.

Prostaglandins E

The E series of prostaglandins, lipid mediators that influence inflammation, vascular tone, gastric protection, kidney blood flow, cervical ripening, and uterine contraction.

Prostaglandins F

The F series of prostaglandins, lipid mediators involved in smooth-muscle contraction, luteal function, vascular responses, inflammation, and labor-related uterine activity.

Prostate

A gland below the bladder surrounding part of the urine tube. It adds fluid to semen and may enlarge, become inflamed, or develop cancer, causing urinary, sexual, or pelvic symptoms.

Prostate Adenocarcinoma

The most common type of prostate cancer, arising from gland cells in the prostate. It often grows slowly but can spread, and its growth is usually stimulated by male sex hormones; grade and stage help determine treatment.

Prostate Biopsy

Removal of small samples of prostate tissue with a needle to look for cancer under a microscope. The needle may pass through the skin between the scrotum and anus or through the rectum; bleeding, infection, and temporary difficulty urinating are possible risks.

Prostate Brachytherapy

Radiation treatment in which small radioactive sources are placed inside or next to the prostate to destroy cancer cells. It is used for selected cancers and may cause temporary urinary or bowel symptoms and later erectile problems.

Prostate Cancer

Cancer that forms in the prostate gland. It may grow slowly or behave aggressively and may cause no symptoms early on. Risk increases with age, family history, inherited gene changes, and certain racial or ethnic backgrounds. Prostate-specific antigen testing and sometimes a digital rectal examination may help evaluate risk, but diagnosis requires a prostate biopsy. Tumor grade and stage help guide treatment.

Prostate Cancer Screening

Prostate cancer screening may use a PSA blood test with or without a digital rectal examination after discussing possible benefits, false positives, and harms.

Prostate Cancer Staging

Determining how far prostate cancer has grown or spread. Clinicians combine examination, PSA level, tumor grade, biopsy findings, and imaging to decide whether it is confined to the prostate, nearby, or in distant organs.

Prostate Cancer Treatment

Care for cancer of the prostate, chosen according to cancer grade, stage, growth rate, age, and health. Options may include active surveillance, surgery, radiation, hormone-blocking treatment, or medicines for advanced disease.

Prostate Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Prostate Cancer*.

Prostatectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the prostate, commonly for prostate cancer or severe urinary obstruction. Possible effects include urinary leakage, erectile dysfunction, bleeding, and infertility.

Prostate Disease

Any disorder affecting the prostate, including benign enlargement, inflammation, infection, or cancer. It may cause difficulty urinating, weak flow, urgency, pelvic pain, blood in urine, or no symptoms initially.

Prostate Enlargement

Alternate name; see *Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia*.

Prostate Enlargement/BPH

Alternate name for benign prostatic hyperplasia, noncancerous enlargement of the prostate that can obstruct urine flow and cause weak stream, urgency, frequency, nighttime urination, or incomplete emptying.

Prostate Gland

The prostate, a gland below the bladder that surrounds the urethra and contributes secretions to semen.

Prostate Gland Enlargement

Alternate name; see *Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia*.

Prostate Infection

Infection or inflammation of the prostate, usually causing pelvic or urinary symptoms and sometimes fever or bloodstream infection.

Prostate Neoplasm

An abnormal mass of cells arising in the prostate. It may be noncancerous, such as a glandular growth, or cancerous; symptoms and treatment depend on its type, size, and spread.

Prostate-Specific Antigen

A protein made mainly by the prostate and measured in blood. A high or rising level can occur with prostate cancer, but also with prostate enlargement, infection, urine retention, ejaculation, or recent procedures. The result is considered with age, examination, trends, and other tests rather than used alone.

Prostate-Specific Antigen Blood Test

A PSA blood test measures prostate-specific antigen; an elevated result may reflect enlargement, inflammation, infection, or cancer and is not diagnostic by itself.

Prostate-Specific Antigen Test

A blood test that measures PSA levels to screen for or monitor prostate disorders, including benign prostatic hyperplasia and prostate cancer; see *Prostate-Specific Antigen Blood Test*.

Prostatic Fluid

Prostatic fluid is a mildly alkaline secretion that forms part of semen and contains substances supporting sperm function and survival.

Prostatic Obstruction

Blockage of urine flow caused by enlargement, inflammation, scarring, stones, or a tumor of the prostate or nearby structures.

Prostatic Urethral Stent

A small device placed in the prostatic urethra to help maintain urine flow when the prostate obstructs it.

Prostatism

Urinary symptoms caused by blockage or poor function at the bladder outlet, often related to an enlarged prostate. Symptoms include weak flow, straining, urgency, frequent urination, nighttime urination, or incomplete emptying.

Prostatitis

Inflammation of the prostate gland. It may be caused by a bacterial infection or by inflammation involving the prostate, pelvic muscles, or nerves without a proven infection. Symptoms may include pain in the pelvis, area between the scrotum and anus, penis, scrotum, lower abdomen, or lower back; painful or frequent urination; difficulty emptying the bladder; painful ejaculation; and, in acute bacterial prostatitis, fever and chills. Recognized types include acute bacterial prostatitis, chronic bacterial prostatitis, chronic prostatitis/chronic pelvic pain syndrome, and asymptomatic inflammatory prostatitis, which causes no symptoms and is found during evaluation for another problem.

Prostatodynia

Prostatodynia is an older term for pelvic or prostate-region pain without proven bacterial infection, now often considered within chronic pelvic pain syndrome.

Prosthesis

An artificial device replacing or supporting a missing body part or function. Prostheses may replace limbs, joints, teeth, eyes, or heart valves and require fitting, care, adjustment, and monitoring.

Prosthetic

Relating to an artificial device that replaces or supports a missing or damaged body part. Examples include artificial limbs, joints, heart valves, teeth, and blood-vessel grafts; complications can include wear, loosening, skin problems, or infection.

Prosthetic Graft

A prosthetic graft is an artificial tube or patch used to replace or bypass a damaged blood vessel or other tubular structure; infection and thrombosis are important risks.

Prosthetic Heart Valve

An artificial valve that replaces a diseased heart valve and keeps blood moving in the correct direction. Mechanical valves are durable but usually require lifelong anticoagulation; tissue valves generally avoid lifelong anticoagulation unless another indication exists but can degenerate over time.

Prosthetic Limb

An artificial limb used to replace some or all of a missing arm or leg. It may improve movement, balance, or daily activities and is fitted to the person's remaining limb, strength, goals, and comfort. Training helps with safe use and skin care.

Prosthetics

The design, fitting, and use of artificial replacements for missing body parts, such as arms, legs, teeth, or eyes. Successful use depends on comfort, strength, balance, skin health, goals, and rehabilitation.

Prosthetic Training

Rehabilitation teaching a person to use an artificial limb safely and effectively. Training includes skin and residual-limb care, putting it on, walking, balance, stairs, transfers, daily activities, and community mobility.

Prosthetic Valve Endocarditis

A severe endocardial infection affecting an artificial mechanical or bioprosthetic heart valve, categorized as early (within one year of implantation, predominantly caused by *Staphylococcus epidermidis* or

Staphylococcus aureus) or late (more than one year post-surgery, mimicking native valve endocarditis).

Alternate Names:
PVE

Prosthodontics

The dental specialty that replaces missing teeth and restores chewing, speech, and appearance. Treatment may use crowns, bridges, implants, dentures, or facial prostheses and is planned around oral health and remaining tissues.

Protamine

A medicine that binds to and reverses the blood-thinning effect of heparin. It is given carefully because it can cause low blood pressure, allergic reactions, slow heart rate, or dangerous clotting.

Protanopia

Protanopia is complete absence of red-cone function, causing a form of red-green color-vision deficiency and altered perception of red and related colors.

Protean

Highly variable in form, appearance, or behavior; in medicine it may describe a disease with changing or diverse manifestations.

Proteaphagy

The process by which a cell uses its recycling system to remove whole proteasomes, the structures that normally break down unwanted proteins. It helps adjust protein disposal during stress or changes in nutrition.

Protease

An enzyme that breaks proteins into smaller pieces by cutting the chemical links between their amino acids. Proteases help digest food and control many processes inside and outside cells.

Protease Inhibitors

Antiviral medicines that block an enzyme viruses need to cut newly made proteins into working parts. They are used for selected viral infections and may interact with many other medicines.

Proteasome

A barrel-shaped protein machine inside cells that breaks down unwanted, damaged, or short-lived proteins. This controls cell growth and signaling and prevents harmful protein buildup.

Proteasome Binding

The attachment of a medicine or other molecule to a cell's protein-destroying machine. This can increase, reduce, or otherwise change the breakdown of proteins and may alter cell survival or function.

Proteasome Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks the proteasome, a cell structure that breaks down unwanted proteins. These drugs are used especially in multiple myeloma and some blood cancers.

Protective

Serving to prevent or reduce injury, infection, or other harm.

Protective Agent

A substance, device, or treatment used to reduce harm to the body. Examples include sunscreen protecting skin from ultraviolet light, barrier creams protecting skin, and medicines that protect the stomach or bones during selected treatments. The appropriate agent depends on the hazard and the person's health.

Protegrin

A small antimicrobial peptide, usually derived from pig immune cells, that can disrupt microbial membranes.

Protein

A large molecule made of one or more chains of amino acids folded into a specific three-dimensional shape. Proteins provide structure and perform functions such as catalyzing reactions, transporting substances, sending signals, regulating cells, and defending against infection; their amino-acid sequence

helps determine their shape and function.

Proteinaceous Plug

A blockage made primarily of protein-rich material, mucus, cellular debris, or secretions that can obstruct an airway, duct, catheter, or other passage.

Protein Acetylation

Addition of an acetyl group to a protein, often changing its activity, localization, stability, or interactions; histone acetylation is a major regulator of gene expression.

Protein Binding

The temporary attachment of a medicine to proteins in the blood. The unattached portion can usually leave the bloodstream, reach tissues, and produce effects; changes in protein levels or other medicines can alter the amount available.

Protein Biosynthesis

The way cells make proteins: they copy information from DNA into messenger RNA, then use ribosomes to join amino acids in the instructed order. The new chain folds and may be modified before it works.

Protein C

A natural blood-clotting regulator that helps prevent excessive clotting. Low levels may be inherited or acquired and increase clot risk; starting warfarin in severe deficiency can rarely cause skin injury.

Protein C Blood Test

A protein C blood test measures a natural anticoagulant and may help evaluate unexplained or recurrent blood clots or suspected inherited deficiency.

Protein C Deficiency

A condition in which too little or poorly functioning protein C reduces the body's natural control of blood clotting. It may be inherited or acquired and increases the risk of deep-vein thrombosis and pulmonary embolism.

Protein Deficiency

Inadequate protein intake, digestion, absorption, or use, causing loss of muscle, impaired immunity and wound healing, edema, or growth failure when severe or prolonged.

Protein Denaturation

Loss of a protein's normal three-dimensional structure from heat, chemicals, pH, or mechanical stress, often impairing its biological function without breaking its peptide backbone.

Protein Dephosphorylation

Removal of a phosphate group from a protein by a phosphatase, often reversing or modifying signaling, enzyme activity, localization, or cell-cycle control.

Protein Electrophoresis

A laboratory test that separates proteins in serum or urine according to their electrical properties, helping detect abnormal protein patterns.

Protein-Energy Malnutrition

Severe lack of calories, protein, or both. It can cause weight loss, muscle wasting, weakness, swelling, poor growth, weak immunity, and slow healing; nutrition must often be restored gradually and carefully.

Protein Engineering

Design or modification of proteins through genetic, biochemical, or computational methods to alter activity, stability, specificity, expression, or therapeutic usefulness.

Protein Expression

The process by which a cell uses genetic instructions to make a protein, then folds, changes, and transports that protein so it can perform its function.

Protein Folding

The process by which a newly made protein bends into the three-dimensional shape needed for its job. Incorrect folding can stop the protein from working or cause harmful protein deposits in cells.

Protein Glycosylation

The attachment of sugar chains to proteins. This helps proteins fold, remain stable, reach the correct part of a cell, and work properly; inherited problems with this process can affect many organs.

Protein Import

Movement of a newly made protein into a cell structure or across a cell membrane. Address labels on the protein and transport systems guide it to the correct location, where it can fold and work properly.

Protein In Diet

Dietary protein supplies amino acids needed for muscle, enzymes, hormones, immunity, and tissue repair; requirements vary with age, health, and kidney function.

Protein Isoform

One of several related protein forms produced from different genes, alternative splicing, or post-translational processing, with potentially different locations or functions.

Protein Kinase

An enzyme that adds a small chemical group to a protein and changes how it works. Protein kinases help control cell signals, metabolism, growth, division, and other functions.

Protein-Losing Enteropathy

Excessive loss of plasma proteins through the gastrointestinal tract, causing low albumin, swelling, diarrhea, or nutritional deficiency.

Protein Malnutrition

Poor health caused by inadequate protein or energy intake, leading to weight loss, muscle wasting, weak immunity, or impaired healing.

Protein Metabolism

The synthesis, folding, modification, breakdown, and recycling of proteins and amino acids in cells and tissues.

Protein Methylation

Addition of small chemical groups called methyl groups to selected parts of a protein. This can change the protein's activity or location and can alter how cells switch genes on or off.

Protein Overexpression

Production of an abnormally large amount of a protein, caused by gene amplification, transcriptional activation, altered degradation, or other mechanisms and potentially driving disease or serving as a biomarker.

Protein Phosphorylation

Attachment of a small phosphate group to a protein by a cell enzyme. This acts like a reversible switch that can change the protein's activity, location, or interactions and helps control cell signals and division.

Protein Prenylation

Attachment of a fat-like chemical group to a protein, helping position it in a cell membrane. This placement allows some proteins to send signals or help move materials within the cell.

Protein Purification

Separation of a desired protein from cells or a mixture using properties such as charge, size, solubility, affinity, or binding, while preserving its structure and activity.

Protein Refolding

Return of a denatured or newly synthesized protein to its functional three-dimensional structure, sometimes requiring chaperones or controlled laboratory conditions.

Protein S

A natural blood protein that helps activated protein C limit clotting. Too little or abnormal protein S can increase the risk of clots in deep veins or the lungs.

Protein S Blood Test

A protein S blood test measures a natural anticoagulant and may help evaluate suspected inherited or acquired tendency to form blood clots.

Protein S Deficiency

A condition in which the blood has too little or poorly functioning protein S, reducing natural control of clotting. It may be inherited or acquired and can increase the risk of deep-vein thrombosis or pulmonary embolism.

Protein Secretion

Release of a protein from a cell or into a particular cell compartment. Cells use this process to send hormones, digestive enzymes, antibodies, and other proteins to where they are needed.

Protein Sequence

The precise order of amino acids joined together to make a protein. This order helps determine the protein's three-dimensional shape, location, interactions, and biological job.

Protein Splicing

A process in which a newly made protein removes an internal section and joins the remaining sections together. The finished protein may then fold into the form needed for its normal function.

Protein Subunit

One protein component of a larger protein assembly. Several subunits may join to create the final structure and allow the assembly to perform its biological function.

Protein Synthesis

The process by which a cell uses messenger RNA instructions to join amino acids into a protein. The resulting protein folds into a working shape and may be changed or moved before performing its function.

Protein Translocation

Movement of a newly synthesized or mature protein across a membrane or to a different cellular compartment, directed by targeting signals and transport machinery.

Protein Transport

Cellular movement of proteins between compartments, across membranes, or outside the cell, ensuring that each protein reaches its functional location.

Protein Unfolding

Loss of a protein's native three-dimensional structure, caused by heat, chemicals, mutations, or cellular stress, which can impair function or promote aggregation.

Proteinuria

An unusually high amount of protein in urine. It can result from kidney disease, diabetes, high blood pressure, infection, exercise, fever, or pregnancy and may require repeat testing to find the cause.

Proteobacteria

A large group of bacteria containing many gram-negative species, including Escherichia, Salmonella, Pseudomonas, and Vibrio. Some are harmless or helpful, while others cause intestinal, urinary, lung, wound, or bloodstream infections.

Proteogenomics

Integration of genomic, transcriptomic, and proteomic data to identify proteins, discover coding variants, characterize tumors or microbes, and connect DNA changes with protein function.

Proteoglycan

A large molecule made of a protein with many attached sugar chains. It helps connective tissues and cartilage hold water, resist pressure, maintain structure, and send signals between cells.

Proteolipid Protein

A protein containing a substantial fat component, especially important in the myelin sheath around nerve fibers.

Proteolipids

Proteins tightly associated with lipid molecules or lipid membranes, important in myelin, mitochondrial membranes, ion transport, and other membrane structures.

Proteolysis

Enzymatic breakdown of proteins into smaller peptides or amino acids. It is needed for digestion, cell regulation, tissue remodeling, and removal of damaged proteins.

Proteolytic

Relating to the breakdown of proteins by cutting the links between their amino acids. Proteolytic enzymes help digest food, activate clotting and immune proteins, remove damaged proteins, and control cell death; medicines can block some of these enzymes.

Proteome

The complete set of proteins produced by a cell, tissue, organism, or biological condition at a particular time.

Proteomic Profile

A proteomic profile is a pattern of proteins measured in a biological sample to study disease, treatment response, or biological processes.

Proteomics

The large-scale study of proteins, including their abundance, structure, modifications, interactions, and functions.

Proteostasis

The balance of protein production, folding, movement, and breakdown that keeps cells functioning. Failure of proteostasis can contribute to aging, neurodegeneration, and other diseases.

Proteus

A group of Gram-negative bacteria that can cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or other infections. Proteus urinary infections may produce urease, raising urine pH and encouraging certain kidney stones.

Proteus Hauseri

A gram-negative bacterium in the Proteus group that is rarely isolated from human clinical specimens.

Proteus Mirabilis

A gram-negative bacterium that commonly causes urinary-tract infection and can produce urease-related kidney or bladder stones.

Proteus Penneri

A gram-negative Proteus species that can rarely cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or other opportunistic infections.

Proteus Syndrome

A rare mosaic overgrowth disorder, usually caused by AKT1 variants, producing asymmetric enlargement of bones, skin, or other tissues and an increased risk of tumors.

Proteus Vulgaris

A gram-negative bacterium that can cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, and other infections and often produces urease.

Prothionamide

A thioamide antimycobacterial drug used as part of selected multidrug regimens for drug-resistant tuberculosis; gastrointestinal, hepatic, neurologic, and thyroid adverse effects require monitoring.

Prothrombin

A blood protein made with the help of vitamin K. When a blood vessel is injured, it is changed into thrombin, which helps form a stable blood clot.

Prothrombin Deficiency

A rare bleeding disorder caused by too little or poorly functioning prothrombin, a protein needed for blood clotting. It can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or prolonged bleeding after injury or surgery.

Prothrombin Time

A blood test measuring how quickly a sample forms a clot. It is often reported as the INR and helps assess clotting disorders, liver disease, vitamin K deficiency, and the effect of warfarin.

Alternate Names:
PT

Proton Pump Inhibitors

Proton pump inhibitors suppress gastric acid secretion and treat reflux, ulcers, and other acid-related disorders; prolonged use can be associated with adverse effects and may have limited benefit when no acid-related disorder is present.

Alternate Names:
PPIs; Proton Pump Inhibitor Medicines

Proton Therapy

Radiation treatment using high-energy protons to damage cancer cells. The beam can deliver much of its dose at a selected depth, potentially reducing radiation to nearby healthy tissue; suitability depends on the tumor and treatment plan.

Proto-Oncogene

A normal gene that helps control cell growth, division, or survival. If it becomes abnormally active because of a genetic change or extra copies, it can act as an oncogene and contribute to cancer.

Protozoa

A traditional group of single-celled organisms with nuclei. Some cause human disease, including malaria, giardiasis, and amoebiasis; modern biological classification places them in several different groups.

Protozoal Infection

Infection caused by a disease-producing protozoan parasite. Protozoal infections may affect the intestine, blood, brain, eyes, skin, or genital tract and include malaria, amoebiasis, giardiasis, leishmaniasis, toxoplasmosis, trichomoniasis, and trypanosomiasis; transmission and treatment depend on the organism and site of disease.

Alternate Names:
Protozoan Disease; Protozoiasis

Protractile

Able to move forward or outward from its usual position. The tongue and lower jaw are examples of body structures that can be actively protruded.

Protractor

An instrument or muscle that moves a body part forward or outward. In anatomy, a protractor muscle may move the jaw, shoulder blade, or another structure away from its usual position.

Protrusion

A part that projects outward or a disc or tissue displaced beyond its normal boundary.

Protuberance

A protuberance is a structure or area that projects outward from a surface, such as a normal bone prominence, swelling, or mass.

Provisional Diagnosis

A temporary working diagnosis made from available evidence before all test results are known, and subject to change.

Provisional Tic Disorder

A disorder with motor or vocal tics lasting less than one year, beginning in childhood and not better explained by another condition.

Provocation

An action or stimulus that brings on a symptom, response, or test finding. Controlled provocation may be used during examination; continuing a stimulus despite dangerous pain can cause harm.

Proximal

Proximal means nearer to the point of attachment or origin; in a limb, the shoulder or hip end is proximal to the hand or foot.

Proximal Deep Vein Thrombosis

A blood clot in a major deep vein of the leg at or above the knee, such as the popliteal, femoral, or iliac vein. It has a higher risk of traveling to the lungs than a clot limited to the calf. It may cause one-sided swelling, warmth, redness, or pain, but some people have no symptoms. Ultrasound and the clinical assessment help establish the diagnosis, and treatment usually includes anticoagulation when safe.

Alternate Names:
Proximal DVT; Above-Knee Deep Vein Thrombosis; Proximal Lower Extremity DVT

Proximal DVT

Alternate name; see *Proximal Deep Vein Thrombosis*.

Proximal Humerus Fractures

Breaks near the upper end of the upper-arm bone, close to the shoulder. They may cause pain, swelling, bruising, and difficulty moving the arm; treatment depends on displacement, joint involvement, bone quality, nerve or blood-vessel injury, and the person's needs.

Proximal Radioulnar Joint

The joint near the elbow where the two forearm bones rotate around each other. It allows the palm to turn up or down; injury or dislocation can limit rotation and cause pain.

Proximal Renal Tubular Acidosis

Proximal renal tubular acidosis occurs when the kidney cannot reclaim enough bicarbonate, causing excess acid in the blood and often low potassium.

Proximal Tubule

The first part of the kidney's microscopic filtering tube after the filtering unit. It returns much of the filtered water, salt, bicarbonate, sugar, amino acids, and phosphate to the blood.

Proximal Tubule Reabsorption

The kidney's return of much of the filtered water and useful substances, including salt, bicarbonate, glucose, amino acids, and phosphate, from the first tubule back into the blood.

Prune Belly Syndrome

A condition present at birth, usually in boys, involving weak or absent abdominal muscles, undescended testicles, and abnormalities of the urinary tract. Kidney problems, repeated infections, breathing difficulty, and impaired growth may occur.

Prurigo

A group of intensely itchy skin disorders with papules or nodules caused by inflammation and scratching.

Prurigo Nodularis

A long-lasting skin disorder with intensely itchy, firm bumps called nodules. Repeated scratching or rubbing causes and maintains an itch–scratch cycle; treatment aims to reduce itching, heal the skin, and prevent new nodules.

Prurigo Pigmentosa

A rare inflammatory skin disorder causing recurrent, intensely itchy red bumps or small blisters, often in a net-like pattern on the chest, back, or neck. As active lesions heal, they may leave a net-like brown discoloration. The condition is often associated with ketosis, such as during a ketogenic diet, fasting, or diabetic ketoacidosis, but it can occur without a recognized cause of ketosis.

Alternate Names:
Nagashima Disease

Pruritic

Itchy or causing an urge to scratch; pruritus can result from skin inflammation, allergy, infection, systemic disease, medications, or neuropathic mechanisms.

Pruritic Eruption

An itchy skin eruption that may result from allergic, inflammatory, infectious, drug-related, or autoimmune disease; diagnosis depends on its morphology, distribution, timing, and associated findings.

Pruritis

Common misspelling of *Pruritus*.

Pruritis Ani

Alternate spelling; see *Anal Itching*.

Pruritus

An itchy feeling that makes a person want to scratch. It can be caused by dry skin, allergies, infection, medicines, or liver, kidney, nerve, and other health problems. Widespread or lasting itching may need medical assessment.

Pruritus and Systemic Disease

Generalized or persistent itching can be a manifestation of kidney or liver disease, iron deficiency, thyroid disease, hematologic disease, diabetes, infection, or malignancy. Examination and targeted tests are guided by the history and associated findings.

Pruritus Ani

Alternate term; see *Anal Itching*.

Pruritus In CKD

Persistent itching associated with advanced chronic kidney disease, often worse in people receiving dialysis. It may occur without a visible rash and can disturb sleep and quality of life; treatment is individualized after other causes are assessed.

Prussian Blue

A blue pigment used in laboratory staining and as an antidote for selected radioactive cesium or thallium poisoning.

PSA

Prostate-specific antigen, a protein made mainly by prostate cells and measured in blood. A raised level may occur with enlargement, inflammation, infection, or cancer and does not diagnose cancer alone.

Alternate Names:
Prostate-Specific Antigen; Total PSA

Psammoma

A tumor or lesion containing rounded, layered calcium deposits called psammoma bodies. These deposits can occur in several tumors and are identified by microscopic examination rather than symptoms alone.

PSA Test

A laboratory blood test that measures prostate-specific antigen (PSA), a protein made mainly by prostate cells. An elevated level may occur with prostate cancer, benign prostate enlargement, or infection or inflammation of the prostate, so the result does not diagnose cancer by itself and varies in significance with clinical context and other findings.

PSA Velocity

The rate at which prostate-specific antigen concentration changes over time. It may provide additional information in prostate evaluation but does not diagnose cancer independently.

Pseudarthrosis

Failure of a broken bone to heal, leaving persistent movement or a false joint at the fracture site. It can cause pain, weakness, deformity, and loss of function and may require surgery.

Pseudoachondroplasia

An inherited skeletal dysplasia, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *COMP*, that affects cartilage and bone growth. Birth length and facial features are typically normal, but growth slows in early childhood, leading to disproportionate short stature, short limbs, joint laxity, and early osteoarthritis. Despite its name, it is distinct from achondroplasia. See also: *Achondroplasia*.

Pseudoamenorrhea

A nonstandard or older label for apparent absence of periods when menstrual blood is trapped behind a blockage; the medical term is *Cryptomenorrhea*.

Alternate Names:
Cryptomenorrhea

Pseudoaneurysm

A weak area or leak in an artery in which blood collects outside the normal artery but remains connected to it. It may follow injury, surgery, infection, or a catheter procedure and can enlarge, burst, or send clots downstream.

Pseudoangiomatous Stromal Hyperplasia

A benign breast stromal proliferation forming slit-like spaces within dense collagen that may mimic vascular channels. It can be incidental or present as a palpable or imaging-detected mass.

Pseudobulbar Affect

Sudden, difficult-to-control episodes of laughing or crying that do not match how a person feels or the situation. It can occur after stroke or with other brain and nerve diseases and is different from depression.

Alternate Names:
PBA; Emotional Incontinence; Pathological Laughter and Crying

Pseudocholinesterase Deficiency

Reduced activity of butyrylcholinesterase, inherited or acquired, causing prolonged paralysis after medicines such as succinylcholine or mivacurium. People may need extended breathing support after anesthesia; enzyme or genetic testing can help confirm the condition.

Pseudoclubbing

Nail-tip broadening or flattening that resembles clubbing but does not have the characteristic change in the angle between the nail and surrounding skin. It may occur with some bone, joint, skin, or inherited conditions.

Pseudo-Cushing Syndrome

A reversible state with clinical or biochemical features resembling cortisol excess without autonomous Cushing disease. Severe alcohol use, depression, obesity, sleep disorders, or acute illness may contribute, and repeat or specialized testing may be needed.

Pseudocyesis

A condition in which a person has pregnancy-like symptoms, such as missed periods, abdominal enlargement, nausea, or breast changes, without an actual pregnancy. A pregnancy test and examination distinguish it from pregnancy and identify other possible causes.

Pseudodementia

Memory and thinking complaints caused by depression or another potentially reversible problem rather than progressive brain-cell loss. Depression and true dementia can occur together or resemble each other.

Pseudoephedrine

An oral decongestant that shrinks swollen blood vessels in the nose and improves blockage from colds or sinus problems. It may raise blood pressure, cause sleeplessness or palpitations, and interact with some medicines.

Pseudofolliculitis of the Beard

An inflammatory reaction caused by shaved or trimmed hairs curling back into the skin, producing itchy or tender papules and pustules in the beard area. Avoiding close shaving, changing shaving technique, and treating inflammation can reduce recurrence and scarring.

Pseudogout

A joint disease caused by calcium pyrophosphate crystals collecting in cartilage. It can cause sudden pain, swelling, warmth, and stiffness, often in a knee or wrist, and may also produce longer-term joint symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Calcium Pyrophosphate Dihydrate Deposition Disease; CPPD

Pseudogout Flare

A sudden attack of joint pain and swelling caused by calcium pyrophosphate crystals. The knee or wrist is often affected; the joint may be red and warm, and fluid testing can confirm the diagnosis.

Pseudogynecomastia

Bilateral enlargement of male breasts due to excessive subareolar and chest wall adipose tissue accumulation without true glandular or ductal tissue proliferation, commonly observed in obesity and distinguishable from true gynecomastia by the absence of a firm, distinct subareolar glandular disc on palpation.

Alternate Names:
Lipomastia; Adipomastia

Pseudohypertrophic Muscular Dystrophy

An older name for Duchenne or related muscular dystrophy with enlarged-appearing muscles caused by fat and connective tissue.

Pseudohypoglycemia

A falsely low glucose measurement that does not reflect the blood glucose available to tissues. It may result from poor peripheral circulation, shock, severe edema, or delayed processing of a blood sample; venous or alternative-site measurements may be more reliable.

Pseudohypoparathyroidism

A group of inherited disorders in which body tissues resist parathyroid hormone (PTH). This often leads to elevated PTH, low blood calcium, and high phosphate; some forms also cause short fingers or other physical features. Pseudohypoparathyroidism is part of the broader group of inactivating PTH/PTH-related peptide signaling disorders (iPPSDs).

Alternate Names:
PHP

Pseudo-Kaposi Sarcoma (Acroangiodermatitis)

A benign vascular eruption, usually on the lower legs or feet, that can resemble Kaposi sarcoma. It is often associated with chronic venous insufficiency, arteriovenous malformations, or dialysis access and may cause violaceous plaques or ulcers.

Pseudomelanosis Duodeni

A usually harmless dark discoloration of the first part of the small intestine seen during endoscopy. It results from pigment-containing material in the lining and may be associated with chronic illness, medicines, or mineral deposits.

Pseudomembranous Colitis

Severe inflammation of the colon, usually caused by overgrowth of Clostridioides difficile after antibiotics. It can cause frequent watery diarrhea, fever, abdominal pain, dehydration, and serious complications.

Alternate Names:
Clostridioides Difficile Colitis; Antibiotic-Associated Colitis

Pseudomonas

A group of Gram-negative bacteria that can cause opportunistic infections, especially in damaged tissues or people with weakened immunity.

Pseudomonas Aeruginosa

A gram-negative bacterium that can cause pneumonia, bloodstream, urinary, wound, and ear infections, especially in hospitalized or immunocompromised people; it often has antibiotic resistance.

Pseudomonas Aeruginosa Infection

Infection caused by Pseudomonas aeruginosa, an opportunistic gram-negative bacterium that can affect the lungs, wounds, urinary tract, blood, or other sites.

Pseudomonas Aeruginosa Resistance

The ability of Pseudomonas aeruginosa to survive medicines that would normally kill it. Resistance may be natural or develop through genetic changes; susceptibility testing identifies active antibiotics.

Pseudomonas Folliculitis

An infection of hair follicles by Pseudomonas aeruginosa, often after exposure to contaminated hot tubs or pools. It causes itchy red papules and pustules under swimwear and usually resolves; severe or recurrent cases can persist or spread.

Pseudomyxoma Peritonei

A rare condition in which jelly-like tumor material gradually fills the abdomen, usually after a mucus-producing appendix tumor ruptures. It can cause increasing abdominal size, pain, bowel blockage, or poor nutrition; treatment may involve extensive abdominal surgery.

Pseudophakia

Having an artificial lens inside the eye after the natural lens has been removed, usually during cataract surgery. The replacement lens focuses light, but later clouding of its supporting capsule or other eye problems can still affect vision.

Pseudoporphyria

A blistering and skin-fragility disorder that resembles porphyria cutanea tarda but occurs without the characteristic porphyrin excess. It may be triggered by kidney failure, dialysis, medicines, or ultraviolet exposure and usually affects the backs of the hands.

Pseudopseudohypoparathyroidism

An inherited condition caused by paternally transmitted mutations in the *GNAS* gene, characterized by the somatic phenotype of Albright hereditary osteodystrophy (short stature, round face, brachydactyly, subcutaneous ossifications) in the presence of completely normal calcium, phosphorus, and parathyroid hormone levels due to intact maternal allele expression in renal tubules.

Alternate Names:
PPHP

Pseudorabies

Aujeszky disease, a herpesvirus infection mainly affecting pigs and other animals. People are rarely infected, but exposed humans may develop serious nervous-system disease; it is different from rabies.

Pseudothrombocytosis Due To Red Cell Fragments

A falsely high platelet count caused when automated equipment mistakes very small broken red-cell fragments for platelets. A blood-smear examination can distinguish this error from a genuinely high platelet count.

Pseudotumor Cerebri

An older name for idiopathic intracranial hypertension, a condition in which pressure around the brain rises without a tumor. It can cause daily headache, brief dimming of vision, whooshing in the ears, and swelling of the optic nerves that may threaten sight.

Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum

A rare inherited disorder in which elastic tissue becomes hardened and damaged. It can cause yellowish or loose skin, bleeding or vision loss from eye blood vessels, and narrowing or bleeding in arteries.

Alternate Names:
PXE; Gronblad-Strandberg Syndrome

Psilocybin

A naturally occurring psychedelic tryptamine found in some fungi. It is converted in the body to psilocin, which acts mainly at serotonin 5-HT2A receptors and alters perception, cognition, and mood. It is under clinical investigation for potential therapeutic uses.

Psittacosis

An infection caused by Chlamydia psittaci, usually acquired by breathing dust from infected birds or their droppings. It commonly causes fever, headache, cough, and pneumonia and requires appropriate antibiotic treatment.

Psittacosis (Parrot Fever)

A systemic infection caused by Chlamydia psittaci, usually acquired from infected birds or their dried secretions. It commonly causes atypical pneumonia with fever, headache, cough, and sometimes hepatitis or neurologic disease; exposure history is diagnostically important.

PSMA

A protein found in large amounts on many prostate cancer cells and in smaller amounts in some normal tissues. Special tracers can use it to show prostate cancer on scans or deliver radiation to cancer cells.

Psoas

A large muscle running from the lower spine to the thigh bone. It helps bend the hip, lift the leg, maintain upright posture, and stabilize the spine during movement.

Psoas Abscess

A collection of pus in or around the psoas muscle, caused by infection spreading through the blood or from nearby tissues. It may cause back or hip pain, fever, difficulty walking, or few symptoms and usually requires imaging and targeted treatment.

Psoas Sign

An abdominal physical examination sign elicited by passive hyperextension of the right hip with the patient in the left lateral decubitus position, or active right hip flexion against resistance; exacerbation of right lower quadrant abdominal pain indicates retrocecal appendicitis inflaming the underlying psoas muscle.

Psoriasis

A chronic immune-mediated skin disease that accelerates epidermal turnover, producing sharply defined, raised, scaly plaques. Plaques often affect the scalp, elbows, knees, trunk, palms, or soles and may look red, purple, brown, or gray depending on skin tone. Nail pitting, thickening, or separation may occur; psoriasis is not contagious.

Psoriatic Arthritis

An inflammatory arthritis associated with psoriasis that can affect peripheral joints, the spine, whole digits (dactylitis), and tendon or ligament attachments (enthesitis). Joint disease may precede, accompany, or follow skin or nail psoriasis.

Alternate Names:
PsA; Arthropathia Psoriatica

Psoriatic Plaque

The characteristic cutaneous lesion of plaque psoriasis (psoriasis vulgaris), consisting of a sharply demarcated, erythematous, indurated plaque covered with adherent, silvery-white micaceous scales, typically distributed symmetrically over extensor surfaces (elbows, knees, scalp, lumbosacral region).

PSP

PSP commonly means progressive supranuclear palsy, a neurodegenerative disorder causing early postural instability, vertical gaze impairment, rigidity, and cognitive change.

Psychiatric

Relating to the assessment, diagnosis, treatment, or prevention of disorders of mood, thought, perception, behavior, or emotional functioning.

Psychiatric Emergency

A mental-health condition involving an immediate and serious risk to life, safety, basic functioning, or the safety of others. Examples include imminent suicide risk, severe psychosis, dangerous agitation, catatonia, or severe substance intoxication or withdrawal. It is a subset of mental-health crises distinguished by the immediacy and severity of risk.

Psychiatrist

A medical doctor who assesses, diagnoses, and treats mental-health conditions. A psychiatrist may provide talking therapy, prescribe medicines, coordinate other treatments, and assess how mental or physical illness affects safety and daily life.

Psychiatry

The branch of medicine concerned with mental, emotional, and behavioral disorders, including substance use disorders. Psychiatrists assess psychological and physical contributors to symptoms and use medical, psychological, and social approaches in the prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of these conditions.

Psychoacoustics

The study of how people perceive and interpret sound, including loudness, pitch, masking, localization, speech, and hearing thresholds.

Psychoactive

Affecting mood, thought, perception, behavior, alertness, or other mental processes. Psychoactive

substances include prescribed medicines, alcohol, and recreational drugs.

Psychoactive Substance

A substance that alters mood, perception, cognition, behavior, or consciousness.

Psychoanalysis

A psychological theory and talking treatment emphasizing unconscious thoughts, feelings, memories, and conflicts. Traditional treatment explores patterns in relationships and behavior, while modern approaches vary in methods, goals, and evidence.

Psychodermatology

The area of care that considers links between skin conditions and emotional health. Stress can worsen problems such as eczema, psoriasis, acne, or hives, while visible skin disease can cause anxiety or low mood; both aspects may need treatment.

Psychodidae

A family of small hairy flies that includes sand flies; some species transmit pathogens such as Leishmania and therefore have public-health importance.

Psychodrama

A therapy using guided acting to explore emotions, relationships, and behavior in a supportive setting.

Psychodynamic Therapy

Talking therapy that explores how past experiences, relationships, feelings, and patterns outside a person's immediate awareness may influence current distress and behavior. The therapist and patient use the therapeutic relationship to develop insight and healthier ways of coping.

Psychogenic

Caused or strongly influenced by psychological factors such as stress, trauma, or emotional conflict. The symptoms are real and not deliberately produced; physical and psychological causes can coexist.

Psychogenic Erectile Dysfunction

Difficulty getting or keeping an erection mainly related to stress, anxiety, depression, relationship concerns, or other emotional factors. Physical causes, medicine effects, and psychological factors can coexist.

Psychogenic Nonepileptic Seizures

Alternate spelling; see *Psychogenic Non-Epileptic Seizures*.

Psychogenic Non-Epileptic Seizures

Episodes that resemble epileptic seizures but are not caused by the abnormal electrical discharges of epilepsy. They are real and involuntary and may involve shaking, stiffening, unresponsiveness, or altered movement; video-EEG can help establish the diagnosis.

Psycholinguistics

The study of how the brain and mind produce, understand, acquire, and remember language, including speech, reading, grammar, and meaning.

Psychological

Relating to thoughts, feelings, behavior, or the way these affect health. Psychological factors can influence pain, sleep, coping, treatment choices, and recovery, but describing a factor as psychological does not mean symptoms are imagined.

Psychological Adjustment

The process of adapting thoughts, emotions, and behavior to stress, illness, disability, loss, developmental change, or other life circumstances.

Psychological Dependence

A pattern in which a person feels a strong emotional or mental need for a substance or behavior, often with craving, preoccupation, or distress when it is unavailable.

Psychological Health

Alternate name; see *Mental Health*.

Psychological Homeostasis

The ongoing adjustment of thoughts, emotions, and behavior that helps a person maintain psychological stability while responding to stress or change. Severe disruption can contribute to anxiety, depression, or impaired daily functioning.

Psychological Support

Emotional and practical help for people coping with illness, disability, pain, or difficult treatment. It may include counseling, coping skills, support groups, and assessment or treatment of anxiety, depression, and adjustment problems.

Psychological Transfer

The process in which feelings, expectations, or relationship patterns from earlier experiences become directed toward someone in the present, especially a therapist. Recognizing this pattern can help understand distress and relationships during therapy.

Psychological Trauma

Emotional or psychological effects that may follow an event or ongoing situation involving actual or threatened death, serious injury, violence, abuse, or another overwhelming experience. Responses vary and may include fear, intrusive memories, avoidance, emotional numbness, sleep problems, or changes in mood and behavior.

Psychology

The scientific study of behavior, emotion, learning, and mental processes. Psychological care may include assessment, counseling, and behavioral therapies.

Psychometrics

The design and use of tests that measure mental abilities, feelings, behavior, or personality. It also examines whether a test gives consistent results and truly measures the quality it claims to measure.

Psychomotor

Relating to the connection between mental activity and physical movement, including the speed, coordination, and purposeful control of actions.

Psychomotor Agitation

Restless, excessive, or purposeless movement associated with inner tension, anxiety, mania, delirium, depression, substance effects, or medication reactions.

Psychomotor Disorder

A condition affecting the speed, starting, coordination, or expression of movement and mental activity. A person may move unusually slowly or quickly, seem restless, or have difficulty organizing purposeful actions.

Psychomotor Performance

The ability to coordinate mental processing with physical movement, assessed through tasks involving speed, precision, reaction time, balance, or sequencing.

Psychomotor Retardation

A noticeable slowing of mental processes, speech output, and physical movements, manifested by decreased spontaneous gestures, prolonged latency in answering questions, sluggish gait, and reduced facial expressiveness. It is a core feature of severe major depressive disorder and melancholia.

Psychoneuroimmunology

The study of how thoughts, emotions, the brain, hormones, and the immune system influence one another in health and illness. It examines links involving stress, inflammation, infection, and recovery.

Psycho-Oncology

The clinical field addressing psychological, social, behavioral, and communication needs of people with cancer and their families during diagnosis, treatment, survivorship, and end-of-life care.

Psychopathic

Describing severe, persistent antisocial traits such as limited empathy, deceitfulness, and disregard for others; it is not a precise diagnosis.

Psychopathology

The study and description of mental symptoms, behaviors, and processes associated with psychological disorders.

Psychopharmacology

The study of how medicines affect mood, behavior, thinking, sleep, and other mental functions in people.

Psychophysics

The study of how physical stimuli, such as light, sound, pressure, or heat, are experienced by a person. It measures detection thresholds, ability to distinguish stimuli, and perceived strength.

Psychophysiology

The study of links between psychological processes and measurable bodily functions such as heart rate, skin conductance, muscle activity, and brain signals.

Psychosexual

Relating to how psychological factors interact with sexual development, feelings, behavior, relationships, or function. Mental health, past experiences, body image, culture, medicines, and physical conditions can all influence sexuality.

Psychosexual Development

Development of sexual identity, interest, relationships, and behavior across the lifespan as influenced by biology, cognition, attachment, culture, and experience.

Psychosis

A state in which a person loses contact with reality. It may involve strongly held false beliefs, hearing or seeing things others do not, confused speech, or markedly disorganized behavior and can result from mental, medical, neurologic, or substance-related causes.

Psychosocial Rehabilitation

Support that helps a person with mental illness build skills, relationships, confidence, and independence. It may include daily-living training, education, work support, peer support, therapy, and help taking part in family and community life.

Psychosocial Support

Practical, emotional, and social help for people facing illness or difficult treatment. It may include counseling, support groups, help with work or money worries, family support, and care for anxiety, depression, fear, loneliness, or grief.

Psychosomatic

Relating to physical symptoms influenced by psychological processes or stress.

Psychosomatic Disorder

An older broad term for physical symptoms influenced by psychological and social factors. The symptoms are real; modern assessment considers both body and mind rather than assuming symptoms are imagined.

Psychosomatic Medicine

Medical care that considers how body processes, thoughts, emotions, relationships, and social conditions interact in illness. Physical symptoms are real, and assessment looks for both medical and psychological factors without assuming symptoms are imagined.

Psychosurgery

Surgery intended to alter brain circuits for severe, treatment-resistant psychiatric illness; it is rarely used and highly specialized.

Psychotherapy

Structured treatment using therapeutic communication and psychological techniques to reduce distress, change unhelpful patterns, and improve coping or relationships. Common approaches include cognitive behavioral and interpersonal therapies.

Psychotic

Describing psychosis, a syndrome involving impaired reality testing. It may include delusions, hallucina-

tions, disorganized thinking or speech, or markedly disorganized behavior. Psychosis can occur with schizophrenia-spectrum disorders, severe mood disorders, substances or medicines, delirium, neurologic disease, or other medical conditions.

Psychotic Disorder

A psychiatric or organic mental disorder characterized by severe impairment in reality testing, manifesting with positive symptoms (delusions, hallucinations, disorganized thinking or speech, and grossly disorganized or catatonic behavior) and negative symptoms (affective flattening, alogia, avolition). The spectrum encompasses schizophrenia, schizoaffective disorder, schizophreniform disorder, brief psychotic disorder, delusional disorder, and secondary psychosis induced by general medical conditions or substances. Management combines dopamine-modulating antipsychotic pharmacotherapy, psychosocial support, and psychotherapy.

Alternate Names:
Psychotic Disorders

Psychotic Disorders

Plural form; see *Psychotic Disorder*.

PTCA

Percutaneous transluminal coronary angioplasty, a procedure using a small balloon to open a narrowed heart artery. A stent is often placed afterward to help keep the artery open and restore blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Percutaneous Transluminal Coronary Angioplasty; Coronary Angioplasty

PTCL

Alternate name; see *T-Cell Lymphoma*.

PTE

Alternate name; see *Pulmonary Thromboendarterectomy*.

Pteridine

A nitrogen-containing chemical structure found in folate vitamins, natural pigments, and other active body compounds. Pteridine-containing molecules participate in cell growth, chemical reactions, color production, and inherited metabolic disorders.

Pterygium

A raised, often triangular growth of tissue with blood vessels that begins on the conjunctiva and extends onto the cornea. Long-term exposure to ultraviolet light, wind, or dust may contribute; it can cause irritation and redness, and growth over the cornea may blur vision or induce astigmatism.

Pterygium Unguis

A scar-like band of tissue that joins the nail fold to the nail bed or nail plate, often dividing or deforming the nail as it grows. It can follow inflammation, injury, or scarring of the nail matrix and is distinct from the eye condition also called pterygium.

Dorsal Pterygium

A scarred band that grows from the proximal nail fold onto the nail bed and nail plate, often forming a V-shaped split in the nail. It can follow nail-matrix scarring, especially from lichen planus or injury, and may permanently alter nail growth.

Ventral Pterygium (Pterygium Inversum Unguis)

An abnormal forward growth of the skin beneath the nail that attaches to the underside of the nail plate. This can seal the space under the nail tip and make trimming or cleaning painful. It differs from dorsal pterygium, which grows from the proximal nail fold.

Pincer Nail Deformity

A nail that curves too far from side to side, so its edges press into the skin alongside it. This most often affects the big toe and may cause pain, inflammation, or an ingrown nail. It can be inherited or develop with injury or other nail disease.

Pterygium Excision

Surgical removal of a pterygium, a fibrovascular growth that extends from the conjunctiva onto the cornea. The exposed area is often covered with a

conjunctival autograft or other tissue graft to reduce recurrence, which can still occur.

Alternate Names:
Pterygium Removal; Pterygium Surgery

Pthirus Pubis

The insect commonly called the pubic louse. It lives mainly in coarse genital hair and causes intense itching and visible lice or eggs; it spreads mainly through close body or sexual contact.

Alternate Names:
Pubic Louse

PTH-Related Peptide

A hormone-like substance sometimes made in excess by cancer cells. It acts partly like parathyroid hormone and can raise blood calcium, causing thirst, constipation, weakness, confusion, dehydration, or kidney problems.

Ptilosis

An abnormal hair pattern or hair disorder, including excess growth, unusual direction, or loss. The term is nonspecific; its meaning depends on body site, appearance, timing, and cause.

PTLD

Post-transplant lymphoproliferative disorder, an abnormal overgrowth of immune cells after organ or stem-cell transplantation. It ranges from a reversible response to lymphoma and may cause fever, swollen lymph nodes, organ problems, or unexplained weight loss.

Ptosis

Drooping of an eyelid or another body structure. Eyelid ptosis may result from muscle, nerve, tendon, aging, injury, or a neurologic disorder.

PTSD

Alternate name; see *Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder*.

Ptyalin

An older name for salivary amylase, the enzyme that begins starch digestion in the mouth.

Ptyalism

Excessive saliva or drooling. It may result from increased saliva production or difficulty swallowing, and can occur with pregnancy, mouth irritation, reflux, medicines, or disorders affecting the brain, nerves, or muscles.

Pubertal Failure

Puberty that does not begin or stops progressing as expected. Causes may involve the brain's hormone centers, pituitary gland, testes or ovaries, chromosomes, chronic illness, inadequate nutrition, excessive exercise, or other factors.

Puberty

The stage when hormone changes cause the body to mature sexually and become capable of reproduction. It includes growth, development of breasts or testes and genitals, body hair, voice changes, and menstrual periods or sperm production.

Puberty In Boys

Puberty in boys is the hormone-driven development of testes, penis, body hair, voice, muscle, and fertility, usually progressing through predictable physical stages.

Puberty In Girls

Puberty in girls is the hormone-driven development of breasts, body hair, growth, menstrual cycles, and reproductive maturity, usually progressing through predictable stages.

Pubes

The area in front of the pelvis over the pubic bone, or the coarse hair that grows there during puberty. Pubic-hair development is one feature of sexual maturation and varies among individuals.

Pubic

Relating to the pubis, the front part of the pelvis, or the area covered by hair above the genitals.

Pubic Lice

Parasitic insects that infest coarse body hair, causing intense itching and visible eggs called nits. They spread mainly through close body contact, often sexual contact.

Alternate Names:
Pediculosis Pubis; Crab Lice

Pubic Symphysis

The joint at the front of the pelvis where the two pubic bones meet. A strong pad of cartilage joins the bones and allows very little movement.

Pubis

The front part of the pelvic bone, meeting its opposite side at the pubic symphysis.

Public Assistance

Government or community support providing eligible people with food, housing, income, healthcare, disability, or other essential services.

Public Exposure

Radiation received by other people from a patient who has undergone nuclear medicine treatment. The amount depends on the radioactive substance and treatment; the medical team gives specific instructions to limit exposure when needed.

Public Health

The science and practice of protecting and improving the health of populations. It includes disease surveillance, prevention, health promotion, policy, environmental health, and organized community action to address shared health risks.

Public Health Emergency

A serious event threatening the health of many people, such as a pandemic, disaster, or deliberate biological attack.

Puborectalis Muscle

A loop-shaped pelvic muscle that surrounds the lower rectum and helps control bowel movements. At rest it pulls the rectum forward to make a bend that helps hold stool; relaxing it helps stool pass.

Pudendal

Relating to the external genitalia, anus, or perineum. The pudendal nerve carries sensation from these areas and helps control several muscles involved in continence and sexual function.

Pudendal Arteries

Arteries supplying blood to the external genital and perineal region.

Pudendal Block

Injection of local anesthetic near the pudendal nerve to numb the lower vagina, vulva, anus, and perineum. It may reduce pain during late labor, assisted delivery, or repair of a birth-related tear.

Pudendal Nerve

The nerve carrying sensation and motor signals to much of the perineum and pelvic floor.

Pudendal Nerve Block

A regional obstetric anesthesia technique in which local anesthetic is infiltrated transvaginally near the ischial spine and sacrospinous ligament to block the pudendal nerve (S2-S4), providing sensory anesthesia to the perineum, vulva, and lower vagina for forceps delivery or episiotomy repair.

Pudendal Neuralgia

Pain caused by irritation or entrapment of the pudendal nerve, often felt in the perineum and worsened by sitting. It may include burning, tingling, altered sensation, or sexual and urinary symptoms; similar pain can have other pelvic causes.

Puerperal

Relating to the period after childbirth, usually the first six weeks. During this time the body recovers from pregnancy and birth, the womb becomes smaller, bleeding gradually settles, and problems such as infection, heavy bleeding, or blood clots may occur.

Puerperal Disorder

A physical or mental health disorder occurring during the postpartum period, including infection, bleeding, hypertension, depression, or psychosis.

Puerperal Fever

Fever occurring after childbirth, often caused by infection of the uterus, birth canal, urinary tract, breast, wound, or bloodstream. Untreated infection can spread and become life-threatening.

Puerperal Infection

An infection after childbirth, commonly involving the uterus, surgical wound, urinary tract, breast, or bloodstream, often causing fever, pain, or foul discharge.

Puerperal Psychosis

A rare, severe psychiatric disorder with rapid onset, usually soon after childbirth. It may involve marked mood changes, confusion, delusions, hallucinations, or disorganized behavior. The acute disturbance can impair judgment and awareness of reality and may pose serious safety risks to the affected parent or infant.

Puerperal Sepsis

A serious infection of the reproductive tract during labor or the six weeks after childbirth. Fever, pelvic pain, foul-smelling discharge, weakness, or fast breathing may occur; treatment includes antibiotics.

Alternate Names:
Postpartum Sepsis; Puerperal Septicemia

Puerperium

The period after childbirth, usually about six weeks, when the body recovers from pregnancy and birth. The uterus shrinks, bleeding settles, milk production develops, and health problems may still arise.

Puffy Eyes

Alternate name; see *Bags Under Eyes*.

Pugilistic Stance

A flexed posture of the arms, hands, and legs sometimes seen in bodies exposed to intense heat. It results from heat-related muscle and tendon contraction, not from purposeful movement, and does not by itself show when or how death occurred.

Pulling A Patient Up In Bed

A safe repositioning technique using adequate staff, friction-reducing equipment, and coordinated movement to move a patient toward the head of the bed while preventing falls, shear, and staff injury.

Pull Test

A standardized clinical test used to evaluate postural stability and balance recovery. The examiner stands behind the patient and delivers a brisk, backward tug to the patient's shoulders; an inability to recover balance within one or two steps indicates impaired postural reflexes in Parkinson's disease or atypical parkinsonism.

Pulmonary

Relating to the lungs or the blood vessels and airways that support breathing. Pulmonary disease may involve infection, asthma, chronic obstructive lung disease, high pressure in lung vessels, blood clots, fluid, scarring, or cancer.

Pulmonary Acinus

The smallest part of the lung that exchanges gases. It begins after a small airway and contains respiratory bronchioles, alveolar ducts, and alveoli where oxygen enters blood and carbon dioxide leaves it.

Pulmonary Actinomycosis

Pulmonary actinomycosis is a chronic bacterial infection of the lungs caused by Actinomyces and may form mass-like lesions or spread across tissue planes.

Pulmonary Alveolar Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the lung's air sacs. It may cause coughing up blood, breathlessness, low oxygen, anemia, and widespread lung shadows and can result from immune disease, infection, medicines, injury, or a clotting problem.

Pulmonary Alveolar Microlithiasis

A rare inherited lung disease in which tiny mineral deposits build up inside the air sacs. It may cause no symptoms at first, but later can lead to cough, breathlessness, low oxygen, and progressive lung scarring.

Pulmonary Alveolar Proteinosis

A rare lung disease in which a fatty material builds up inside the air sacs and interferes with oxygen exchange. It can cause gradually worsening breathlessness, cough, tiredness, and low oxygen and may be immune-related or secondary to another illness.

Pulmonary Angiography

Contrast imaging of the pulmonary arteries, usually by catheter. It can diagnose pulmonary vascular abnormalities but is now used less often for pulmonary embolism because CT pulmonary angiography is less invasive.

Pulmonary Arterial Hypertension

Group 1 pulmonary hypertension, characterized by disease of the small pulmonary arteries and precapillary hemodynamics on right-heart catheterization: mean pulmonary arterial pressure above 20 mmHg, pulmonary arterial wedge pressure at or below 15 mmHg, and pulmonary vascular resistance above 2 Wood units. It may be idiopathic, heritable, drug-associated, or linked to connective-tissue disease, HIV, portal hypertension, congenital heart disease, or schistosomiasis. It may cause exertional breathlessness, fatigue, chest discomfort, dizziness, fainting, or swelling.

Pulmonary Arteries

The two large blood vessels carrying oxygen-poor blood from the right side of the heart to the lungs. In the lungs, the blood releases carbon dioxide and picks up oxygen.

Pulmonary Arteriovenous Fistula

An abnormal direct connection between an artery and vein in the lung that lets blood bypass normal oxygen exchange. It can cause low oxygen, breathlessness, blue skin, stroke-causing clots, or rarely a brain abscess.

Pulmonary Arteriovenous Malformation

An abnormal direct connection between an artery and vein in the lung. Blood bypasses normal oxygen exchange, which can cause low oxygen, breathlessness, coughing blood, stroke, or a brain abscess; some cases are linked to an inherited blood-vessel disorder.

Pulmonary Artery

The large blood vessel carrying oxygen-poor blood from the right side of the heart to the lungs. There, blood releases carbon dioxide, receives oxygen, and returns through pulmonary veins.

Pulmonary Artery Catheter

A thin tube passed through the right side of the heart into a lung artery to measure pressures, blood flow, and heart performance. It is used selectively in severe heart or lung disease and critical illness because insertion has risks.

Pulmonary-Artery Dissection

A rare, life-threatening tear in the wall of an artery carrying blood from the heart to the lungs. It may cause sudden chest pain, breathlessness, low blood pressure, or collapse.

Pulmonary Artery Pulsatility Index

A measurement calculated during right-heart catheterization from pulmonary-artery pressure and right-atrial pressure. A low result may indicate weak right-ventricle pumping and a higher risk of right-sided heart failure in seriously ill patients.

Alternate Names:
PAPi; PAP Index

Pulmonary Artery Wedge Pressure

An indirect hemodynamic measure of left atrial pressure and left ventricular end-diastolic filling pressure, obtained by inflating a balloon at the tip of a pulmonary artery catheter (Swan-Ganz) until it occludes a small pulmonary arterial branch.

Alternate Names:

PAWP; PCWP; Pulmonary Capillary Wedge Pressure

Pulmonary Aspergilloma

A pulmonary aspergilloma is a ball of Aspergillus fungus and debris growing in a pre-existing lung cavity, sometimes causing coughing of blood.

Pulmonary Aspergillosis

Infection or allergic disease in the lungs caused by Aspergillus mold. It may cause an allergic reaction in the airways, a mold ball in an old lung cavity, or invasive infection that damages lung tissue, especially when immune defenses are weak.

Pulmonary Atresia

A heart defect present from birth in which the valve or passage from the right ventricle to the pulmonary artery does not open normally. Blood cannot reach the lungs through the usual route, so newborns may become blue or severely unwell; treatment often involves catheter procedures or surgery.

Pulmonary Blastoma

A rare malignant lung tumor composed of primitive epithelial and mesenchymal tissue, usually treated with specialist oncology care.

Pulmonary Capillary Wedge Pressure

A pressure measured with a special catheter in a small lung artery to estimate pressure on the left side of the heart. It can help assess heart failure or fluid overload in critically ill patients, but breathing support and other conditions affect its meaning.

Pulmonary Circuit

The circulation in which blood travels from the right ventricle to the lungs for gas exchange and returns to the left atrium.

Pulmonary Circulation

The blood-flow circuit from the right ventricle through the pulmonary arteries and lung capillaries to the left atrium, where blood releases carbon dioxide and gains oxygen.

Pulmonary Coccidioidomycosis

Lung infection caused by breathing in spores of Coccidioides fungi, which live in soil in some regions. It may cause cough, fever, tiredness, or chest pain. Most disease stays in the lungs, but in some people it spreads to the skin, bones, joints, or brain.

Pulmonary Compliance

How easily the lungs expand when pressure changes during breathing. Low compliance means the lungs are stiff and harder to inflate; high compliance can mean they expand easily but may not recoil effectively.

Pulmonary Contusion

Bruising of the lung after a blow or crush injury to the chest. Bleeding and swelling inside the lung can reduce oxygen exchange and worsen during the first day or two; treatment supports breathing and addresses associated injuries.

Pulmonary Disease and Pregnancy

Lung disease can worsen during pregnancy or be affected by pregnancy-related changes in oxygen demand and ventilation. Asthma, pneumonia, pulmonary embolism, and chronic lung disease can cause severe or new breathlessness, chest pain, or low oxygen.

Pulmonary Edema

A buildup of fluid in the lungs that can make breathing difficult. It is often caused by heart failure but may also result from kidney problems, lung injury, medicines, or high altitude. Fluid in the air sacs can reduce oxygen in the blood and, when severe, cause respiratory failure.

Alternate Names:
Fluid in the Lungs; Pulmonary Congestion; Alveolar Flooding

Pulmonary Embolism

A potentially life-threatening medical emergency caused by a sudden blockage in one or more arteries in the lungs, most commonly by a blood clot that has traveled through the bloodstream from the deep veins of the legs or pelvis (deep vein thrombo-

sis). The blockage prevents oxygen-poor blood from reaching the lung tissue to pick up oxygen, putting sudden strain on the heart and reducing oxygen levels in the body. Common symptoms include sudden shortness of breath, sharp chest pain (especially when taking a deep breath), rapid breathing, coughing up blood, and lightheadedness.

Alternate Names:
PE; Pulmonary Thromboembolism; Blood Clot in Lungs

Pulmonary Embolism Treatment

Treatment for a blood clot in the lung usually uses anticoagulant medicine to stop growth and prevent new clots. Severe or unstable cases may need clot-dissolving medicine or a procedure; choice and duration depend on the person's risks and cause.

Pulmonary Embolus

A blockage of a pulmonary artery, usually by a blood clot that traveled from a deep vein, causing sudden breathlessness, chest pain, low oxygen, or collapse.

Pulmonary Emphysema

Alternate name; see *Emphysema*.

Pulmonary Eosinophilia

A group of disorders in which eosinophils accumulate in lung tissue or air spaces, causing infiltrates, cough, wheezing, breathlessness, or low oxygen. Causes include parasites, medicines, asthma, allergic disease, and eosinophilic lung syndromes; treatment targets the cause and inflammation.

Pulmonary Fibrosis

Scarring and stiffening of lung tissue, often as part of an interstitial lung disease. The scarring can make it harder for the lungs to expand and for oxygen to pass into the blood. It may cause worsening shortness of breath, a dry cough, and tiredness. Causes include some autoimmune diseases, medicines, radiation, and inhaled dusts or chemicals; sometimes no cause is found. Idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis is a specific type with no known cause.

Pulmonary Fistula

An abnormal passage between the lung or an airway and another structure, such as the space around the lung, skin, or swallowing tube. It can allow air or infected fluid to travel where it should not.

Pulmonary Function Test

Singular variant; see *Pulmonary Function Tests*.

Pulmonary Function Tests

Breathing tests that measure how much air the lungs hold, how quickly air can be moved, and how well oxygen passes into the blood. They help assess asthma, chronic obstructive lung disease, scarring, and other breathing problems. Results depend on effort, technique, age, and body size.

Pulmonary Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the airways or lung tissue, which may cause coughing blood, low oxygen, anemia, or respiratory failure.

Pulmonary Hemosiderosis

A condition in which repeated bleeding into the lung's air sacs leaves iron deposits behind. It may cause cough, breathlessness, coughing blood, anemia, and low oxygen and can result from immune disease or other causes.

Pulmonary Histoplasmosis

Lung infection caused by breathing in spores of the Histoplasma fungus, often from soil contaminated by bird or bat droppings. It may cause no symptoms or a flu-like illness with cough, fever, and chest discomfort; severe or widespread illness is more likely with weakened immunity.

Pulmonary Hypertension

Abnormally high pressure in the pulmonary circulation, defined as a mean pulmonary arterial pressure above 20 mmHg at rest, measured by right-heart catheterization. It may result from left-heart disease, lung disease or hypoxia, chronic pulmonary-artery obstruction, pulmonary arterial disease, or other conditions. The cause determines its classification; persistent pressure elevation can strain the

right ventricle.

Alternate Names:
PH; High Blood Pressure in the Lungs

Pulmonary Hypertension Classification

A clinical grouping based on cause: disease of the pulmonary arteries, left-sided heart disease, lung disease or low oxygen, chronic blood clots, or several other mechanisms. Identifying the group guides testing and treatment because medicines useful for one group may be harmful in another.

Pulmonary Hypertension Due to Another Condition

Pulmonary hypertension associated with another condition, such as left-heart disease, lung disease or hypoxia, chronic blood clots, or systemic disease. Classification by cause guides evaluation and treatment.

Pulmonary Hypoplasia

Underdevelopment of one or both lungs, resulting in too little lung tissue for normal breathing. It may occur with congenital abnormalities, low amniotic fluid, or compression before birth.

Pulmonary Infarction

Death of a small area of lung tissue after its blood supply is blocked, usually by a pulmonary embolism. It may cause sharp pain with breathing, coughing up blood, breathlessness, or a shadow on imaging.

Pulmonary Infection

An infection of the lungs or lower respiratory tract caused by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or other organisms.

Pulmonary Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis

A rare lung disease strongly linked to cigarette smoking, in which unusual immune cells damage small airways and form lung cysts. It can cause cough, breathlessness, chest pain, or a collapsed lung. Disease activity may stabilize after smoking cessation; progressive disease may involve systemic treatment.

Alternate Names:
PLCH; Histiocytosis X of the Lung; Pulmonary Eosinophilic Granuloma

Pulmonary Lobes

The anatomical divisions of the lungs separated by interlobar fissures. The right lung has superior, middle, and inferior lobes; the left lung has superior and inferior lobes and a lingula.

Pulmonary Lymphangioleiomyomatosis

Alternate name; see *Lymphangioleiomyomatosis*.

Pulmonary Lymphangiomyomatosis

Alternate spelling for lymphangioleiomyomatosis, a rare cystic lung disease that mainly affects women and can cause progressive breathlessness, recurrent pneumothorax, chylous effusions, and abnormal growth of smooth-muscle-like cells.

Pulmonary Mass

A space-occupying lesion in or near the lung, which may represent infection, inflammation, benign growth, or cancer and requires appropriate imaging assessment.

Pulmonary Mucormycosis

An invasive lung infection caused by inhaled molds of the order Mucorales. It mainly affects people with weakened immune defenses or uncontrolled diabetes and can cause rapidly progressive pneumonia, invade blood vessels, destroy lung tissue, or spread to other organs.

Pulmonary Nocardiosis

A lung infection caused by Nocardia bacteria, usually affecting people with weakened immunity and sometimes spreading to the brain or skin.

Pulmonary Nodule

A small, rounded spot in the lung seen on imaging, measuring 3 cm or less. It may result from infection, inflammation, scarring, or a benign or cancerous growth.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonary Nodules

Pulmonary Oedema

Fluid collecting in lung tissue or air sacs, making breathing difficult and reducing oxygen transfer. It often results from heart failure but can also follow infection, toxins, kidney disease, or severe injury.

Pulmonary Reactance

A measure of how the stretch and movement of the lungs and chest wall affect airflow during breathing. It is obtained during specialized tests and can help describe stiffness or altered movement of the respiratory system.

Pulmonary Regurgitation (Pulmonic Regurgitation)

Backward flow from the pulmonary artery into the right ventricle during diastole because the pulmonary valve does not close completely. Mild regurgitation may be asymptomatic, whereas severe or long-standing regurgitation can enlarge or weaken the right ventricle and cause exercise intolerance, arrhythmias, or right-sided heart failure.

Pulmonary Rehabilitation

A supervised, multidisciplinary program combining exercise training, education, behavioral support, and self-management for chronic respiratory disease. It improves exercise capacity, dyspnea, functional status, and quality of life.

Pulmonary-Renal Syndrome

A group of diseases that cause inflammation or bleeding in the lungs together with inflammation or injury in the kidneys. It is often associated with small-vessel vasculitis or another autoimmune disease.

Pulmonary Sequestration

A birth-related area of lung tissue that does not connect normally to the airways and receives blood from an unusual artery. It may cause repeated lung infections, cough, or breathing problems, although some cases cause no symptoms.

Pulmonary Stenosis

Narrowing that obstructs blood leaving the right ventricle on its way to the lungs, usually at the pulmonary valve. It is often congenital and increases right-ventricular pressure; severe disease may cause a murmur, fatigue, breathlessness, fainting, or right-heart failure.

Pulmonary Surfactant

A slippery mixture made by cells lining the lung's air sacs that reduces surface tension and helps keep the sacs open. Too little in premature babies can cause serious breathing difficulty.

Pulmonary Thrombectomy

The surgical or catheter-directed extraction of a blood clot from the pulmonary arterial bed to restore blood flow in massive pulmonary embolism; see *Thrombectomy*.

Pulmonary Thromboendarterectomy

Major surgery to remove old clots and scar tissue from the arteries of the lungs. It may improve or cure long-term clot-related high blood pressure in the lungs in selected people, but it carries serious surgical risks.

Alternate Names:
PTE; Pulmonary Endarterectomy; PEA

Pulmonary Trunk

The large vessel leaving the right ventricle that divides into the right and left pulmonary arteries.

Pulmonary Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis infection involving the lungs, caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis. It may cause prolonged cough, fever, night sweats, weight loss, or coughing blood and can spread through the air.

Pulmonary Valve

A one-way valve between the right lower heart chamber and the artery leading to the lungs. It opens to let blood leave the heart and closes to prevent backward flow; narrowing or leakage can strain the right side of the heart.

Pulmonary Valve Insufficiency

Leakage of blood backward through the pulmonary valve into the right lower heart chamber while the heart relaxes. Mild leakage may cause no symptoms, but severe disease can enlarge the heart and reduce exercise ability.

Pulmonary Valve Regurgitation

Leakage through the pulmonary valve that allows blood to flow back into the right lower heart chamber as the heart relaxes. Mild leakage may cause no symptoms; severe leakage can enlarge and weaken the right side of the heart.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonic Regurgitation; Pulmonary Incompetence; PR

Pulmonary Valve Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Pulmonic Valve Stenosis*.

Pulmonary Vascular Resistance

The opposition to blood flow through the lung blood vessels. High resistance makes the right side of the heart pump harder and can lead to high pressure in the lungs, right-heart enlargement, and heart failure.

Pulmonary Vasculitis

Inflammation of blood vessels in the lungs. It may affect tiny vessels around the air sacs and cause bleeding, breathlessness, or low oxygen. It often occurs as part of a blood-vessel disease that also affects other parts of the body. Symptoms depend on the vessels and organs involved.

Pulmonary Vasodilator Therapy

Treatment with medicines that widen blood vessels in the lungs and lower pressure on the right side of the heart. It is used for selected types of pulmonary hypertension after specialist testing because it may be harmful in other types.

Pulmonary Vein

One of the four large veins (superior and inferior left, superior and inferior right) that carry oxygen-rich blood from the capillary beds of the pulmonary alveoli back to the left atrium of the heart, representing an essential exception to the rule that veins carry deoxygenated blood.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonary Veins

Pulmonary Vein Isolation

A catheter procedure for selected people with atrial fibrillation. The clinician creates small areas of scar around the veins entering the upper heart chamber to block abnormal electrical signals. It can reduce episodes but may not cure them; bleeding, stroke, narrowing of a vein, or other complications are possible.

Alternate Names:
PVI; Antral Pulmonary Vein Isolation; AFib Catheter Ablation

Pulmonary Veins

Plural form; see *Pulmonary Vein*.

Pulmonary Veno-Occlusive Disease

A rare progressive disease in which small veins in the lungs become narrowed or blocked. Pressure then rises in the lung circulation, causing breathlessness and low oxygen; some medicines for pulmonary hypertension can trigger life-threatening fluid in the lungs.

Pulmonary Ventilation

The movement of air into and out of the lungs. It brings oxygen into the air sacs and removes carbon dioxide; inadequate ventilation can cause low oxygen or a buildup of carbon dioxide.

Pulmonary Ventilation/Perfusion Scan

An imaging test comparing air reaching different lung regions with blood flow through those regions. A mismatch may suggest a blood clot in the lung, while other patterns can indicate lung or blood-vessel disease.

Pulmonary Wedge Pressure

A pressure measured through a special catheter in

a small lung artery to estimate the pressure in the left side of the heart. It helps assess fluid overload or heart failure in seriously ill patients.

Pulmonic Valve Stenosis

A narrowing or stiffening of the pulmonic valve, which controls blood flow from the heart's right lower chamber into the pulmonary artery leading to the lungs. This narrowing forces the heart to work harder to pump blood to the lungs. Typically present from birth, mild cases may cause no symptoms, while more severe narrowing can lead to a heart murmur, shortness of breath during exertion, fatigue, chest discomfort, or swelling in the legs.

Pulmonologist

A pulmonologist is a physician specializing in diseases of the lungs and breathing system, including asthma, COPD, infections, and sleep-related breathing disorders.

Pulmonology

The medical specialty concerned with the lungs and breathing system. Pulmonologists diagnose and treat asthma, chronic lung disease, infections, sleep-related breathing disorders, and other respiratory conditions.

Pulp

The soft living tissue in the center of a tooth, containing nerves and blood vessels. It can become inflamed or infected after decay, cracks, or injury and may then require root-canal treatment or removal.

Pulp Canal

The pulp canal is the passage within a tooth root containing dental pulp, nerves, and blood vessels; infection may require root-canal treatment.

Pulp Disease

A problem affecting the living tissue inside a tooth, including inflammation, infection, loss of blood supply, or tissue death. It may cause toothache or sensitivity and can follow decay, a crack, a filling, or injury.

Pulpectomy

Complete removal of infected or damaged pulp from inside a tooth, usually a primary tooth. The space is cleaned and filled with a material that can safely resorb as the adult tooth develops.

Pulpitis

Inflammation of the dental pulp, usually caused by caries, trauma, cracks, or restorative treatment. Reversible pulpitis causes brief pain provoked by cold or sweet stimuli; irreversible pulpitis causes spontaneous or lingering pain and may progress to pulp necrosis, requiring endodontic treatment or extraction.

Pulposus

Relating to the nucleus pulposus, the gelatinous central portion of an intervertebral disk. Relating to the soft, jelly-like center of an intervertebral disk, which helps cushion spinal movement.

Pulpotomy

Removal of inflamed soft tissue from the crown of a baby tooth while keeping the root tissue alive. It treats suitable decay or injury and preserves the tooth until it naturally falls out.

Pulp Stone

A small area of hardened mineral inside the soft center of a tooth. It often causes no symptoms and is found on dental imaging, but it may complicate root-canal treatment if it blocks the canal.

Pulsatile Proptosis

An abnormal forward protrusion of the eyeball characterized by visible or palpable pulsations synchronous with the arterial pulse, classically accompanied by an audible orbital bruit. It is a cardinal sign of a direct carotid-cavernous fistula or congenital sphenoid wing dysplasia in neurofibromatosis type 1.

Pulsatile Tinnitus

A rhythmical acoustic sound perceived in one or both ears that beats synchronously with the patient's heartbeat, frequently signifying an underly-

ing vascular anomaly such as dural arteriovenous fistula, internal carotid artery dissection, carotid stenosis, glomus jugulare tumor, or idiopathic intracranial hypertension.

Pulse

A pulse is the rhythmic expansion of an artery produced by each heartbeat; its rate, rhythm, strength, and symmetry provide clues about circulation and cardiac function.

Pulse Examination

Checking arterial pulses for speed, regularity, strength, and equality on both sides. It helps assess blood flow, heart rhythm, circulation to limbs, and possible blockage or reduced blood supply.

Pulse Irregular

An irregular pulse has uneven timing or varying beats and may reflect premature beats, atrial fibrillation, other arrhythmias, or measurement variation.

Pulseless Disease

Takayasu arteritis, an inflammation of large arteries that can narrow or block blood flow. It may cause weak pulses, unequal blood pressure, limb pain, dizziness, vision problems, or organ damage.

Pulseless Electrical Activity

A cardiac-arrest state in which the electrocardiogram shows organized electrical activity but there is no palpable pulse or effective blood flow. The electrical pattern can resemble a rhythm that normally produces circulation; the absence of a pulse distinguishes pulseless electrical activity from a perfusing rhythm. It is classified as a non-shockable arrest rhythm.

Pulse Oximeter

A small device, often placed on a fingertip, that estimates blood oxygen and pulse rate using light. Movement, cold fingers, poor circulation, nail products, and device limitations can make the reading inaccurate.

Pulse Oximetry

A painless method of estimating blood oxygen with a light-based sensor, usually on a finger, toe, or ear. Accuracy varies with circulation, skin pigmentation, movement, and other factors.

Pulse Pressure

The systolic blood pressure minus the diastolic blood pressure. A widened or narrowed value may provide clues about circulation and is considered with the full blood-pressure reading and clinical context.

Pulse Rate

Pulse rate is the number of palpable arterial beats per minute and usually approximates heart rate, although some arrhythmias produce a pulse deficit.

Pulsus

A term used in medicine to describe the pulse and named patterns of arterial beats. The pattern may provide clues about heart rhythm, pumping strength, blood-vessel resistance, breathing, or circulation.

Pulsus Alternans

A pulse rhythm where strong and weak beats alternate back and forth, showing that the main heart pump is weak and struggling.

Pulsus Bisferiens

A pulse with two distinct peaks during each heartbeat. It may occur with certain severe aortic-valve disorders or hypertrophic obstructive cardiomyopathy and requires interpretation with other examination findings.

Alternate Names:
Biphasic Pulse; Bisferious Pulse

Pulsus Paradoxus

An unusually large drop in blood pressure during breathing in, usually more than 10 millimeters of mercury. It can occur when the heart is compressed by fluid, or during severe asthma, chronic lung disease, or other heart conditions.

Pulsus Parvus et Tardus

A weak, slow-rising pulse in the neck. It may occur with severe narrowing of the aortic valve but is not specific and can accompany other findings of heart disease.

Alternate Names:
Anacrotic Pulse; Slow-Rising Arterial Pulse

Pulvinar

A region at the back of the thalamus, a deep brain structure. It helps direct visual attention, combine sensory information, and communicate with areas of the cerebral cortex.

Pumice

A porous volcanic stone used as an abrasive; excessive dust inhalation can irritate the lungs.

Pump Failure

Inability of the heart to pump enough blood to meet the body's needs. It may cause breathlessness, fatigue, fluid buildup, or low blood pressure; the cause and severity determine treatment.

Alternate Names:
Acute Ventricular Failure

Pump Lung

An older occupational term for byssinosis, a work-related airway disease caused by inhalation of cotton, flax, or hemp dust. Symptoms may include chest tightness, cough, wheezing, and breathlessness that worsen during or after workplace exposure.

Pump-Oxygenator

The part of a heart-lung machine that moves blood and adds oxygen while removing carbon dioxide during some heart operations. It temporarily replaces the pumping and gas-exchange work of the heart and lungs. Use can be associated with bleeding, inflammation, clots, or organ complications.

Punch Biopsy

A dermatological procedure in which a circular, hollow blade instrument is rotated through the skin into the subcutaneous fat to obtain a full-thickness cylindrical specimen of skin tissue for histopathological examination.

Alternate Names:
Punch Biopsy

Punctal Occlusion

Partial or complete blocking of the small tear-drain openings near the inner eyelids, often with plugs or a procedure, to keep tears on the eye surface. It may help selected people with dry eye; watering, irritation, or infection can occur.

Punctate

Made up of, or marked by, small spots, dots, or points. The term describes appearance and does not by itself identify a diagnosis.

Punctate Palmoplantar Keratoderma

An inherited condition causing many small, hard areas of thickened skin on the palms and soles. It often begins in adolescence or adulthood and can make walking or using the hands painful; rarely, a skin cancer develops.

Puncture

A small hole or wound made by a pointed object, needle, bite, or sharp instrument. A puncture may be intentional for an injection or sample, or accidental and may carry infection, bleeding, or deeper injury risks.

Puncture Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Needle Biopsy*.

Puncture Wound

A wound produced when a pointed object penetrates the skin and underlying tissue, creating a small surface opening with potentially deep tissue damage and infection risk.

Pungent

Describes a strong, sharp smell or taste that may irritate the nose, mouth, eyes, or other moist linings.

Punicic Acid

A conjugated polyunsaturated fatty acid found mainly in pomegranate seed oil and studied for lipid and inflammatory effects; clinical supplement benefits remain uncertain.

Punishment

Punishment is a consequence intended to reduce a behavior; in healthcare, coercive or harmful punishment is inappropriate and behavior support should prioritize safety and dignity.

Pupil

The central opening in the colored iris through which light enters the eye. Muscles change its size to control incoming light, and unequal or poorly reactive pupils may indicate eye or nerve disease.

Pupillary

Relating to the pupil, the opening in the iris that controls how much light enters the eye. The pupil normally becomes smaller in bright light and larger in dim light; unequal size or poor reaction can indicate an eye, nerve, or brain problem.

Pupillary Light Reflex

The normal narrowing of the pupil when light enters the eye. It tests the eye, optic nerve, brain pathways, and nerves that control the pupil.

Pure Cutaneous Histiocytosis

A rare disorder in which abnormal histiocytes accumulate in the skin without recognized internal-organ involvement. It can produce papules, nodules, or plaques and must be distinguished from systemic histiocytic disease.

Pure Red Cell Aplasia

A rare disorder in which the bone marrow stops making red blood cells while other blood cells may remain normal. It causes severe anemia, tiredness, breathlessness, and pale skin and may be inherited or acquired from infection, immune disease, cancer, or medicines.

Alternate Names:
PRCA; Erythroblastopenia

Pure Tone Audiometry

A hearing test in which a person signals whenever they hear tones of different pitches and loudness. It measures the quietest sounds detectable through air and bone and helps identify the type and degree of hearing loss.

Pure-Tone Audiometry

A hearing test that measures the softest tones a person can hear at selected frequencies through air and bone conduction. The results are plotted on an audiogram and help distinguish conductive from sensorineural hearing loss.

Alternate Names:
Pure-Tone Threshold Audiometry; Pure-Tone Hearing Test

Purgative

A strong laxative that causes rapid emptying of the bowel. It may be used for bowel preparation before some procedures, but excessive use can cause diarrhea, dehydration, and dangerous changes in body salts.

Purge

To empty the bowel, stomach, or body of a substance; the term may also mean forceful vomiting or diarrhea.

Purging

Deliberate behaviors intended to compensate for eating, such as self-induced vomiting or misuse of laxatives, diuretics, or excessive exercise.

Purging Disorder

Repeated self-induced vomiting or misuse of laxatives, diuretics, or other methods to influence weight or body shape without recurrent binge eating. It can cause dangerous salt disturbances, tooth damage, dehydration, heart-rhythm problems, and tears in the food pipe.

Purine

A heterocyclic aromatic organic compound composed of fused pyrimidine and imidazole rings that serves as the biochemical backbone for adenine and guanine in DNA, RNA, ATP, and coenzymes. Catabolism of purines in humans proceeds through xanthine oxidase to yield uric acid; excess accumulation or impaired renal excretion of uric acid causes hyperuricemia, leading to gouty arthritis and nephrolithiasis.

Alternate Names:
Purines

Purine Nucleosides

Molecules made from a purine base, such as adenine or guanine, joined to a sugar. Examples include adenosine and guanosine, which help form genetic material and participate in cell energy and signaling.

Purine Nucleotides

Molecules containing adenine or guanine joined to a sugar and phosphate groups. They build DNA and RNA and include ATP and GTP, which store energy and help transmit signals inside cells.

Purines

Plural form; see *Purine*.

Purinoceptor

A protein on a cell's surface that detects substances such as ATP, ADP, or adenosine outside the cell. It helps regulate cell communication, inflammation, blood-vessel activity, and other body responses.

Purkinje Cell

A major nerve cell in the cerebellum, the brain region that coordinates movement and balance. It sends signals that help fine-tune posture, coordination, and learned movements.

Purkinje Fibers

Special electrical fibers spread through the lower chambers of the heart. They rapidly carry each heartbeat's signal so the ventricles contract together and pump blood efficiently.

Purkinje Fibres

Specialized heart-muscle fibers that rapidly spread electrical signals through the ventricles. Their coordinated activity helps the lower chambers contract together and pump blood efficiently to the lungs and body.

Purpura

Red, purple, or brown spots or patches caused by blood leaking under the skin or the moist lining of the mouth. They do not fade when pressed. Causes include low platelet counts, blood-clotting problems, fragile blood vessels, or inflammation of small blood vessels.

Purpura Fulminans

A rapidly worsening, life-threatening condition in which widespread blood clots and clotting-system failure cause purple skin patches, bleeding, and tissue death. It can follow severe infection, loss of natural anticoagulants, or another serious illness.

Purpura Hemorrhagica ITP

Alternate name; see *Immune Thrombocytopenia*.

Purpuric Spots

Alternate name; see *Purpura*.

Pursed-Lip Breathing

A way to breathe out slowly through nearly closed lips, as if gently whistling. It may help slow breathing and ease shortness of breath in some people with lung disease.

Purse-lip Respiration

Alternate name; see *Pursed-Lip Breathing*.

Purulent

Containing or producing pus, a thick fluid made of immune cells, dead tissue, and often germs. Purulent drainage can occur in an abscess or infected wound, but its appearance alone does not identify the organism or the treatment needed.

Purulent Pericarditis

A serious bacterial infection of the sac around the heart, causing pus and fluid to collect there. Fever, chest pain, breathlessness, and pressure on the heart may occur; treatment commonly includes drainage and antibiotics.

Pus

A thick fluid made of dead cells, germs, immune cells, and damaged tissue. It commonly collects during infection and may appear in wounds, abscesses, infected organs, or other inflamed body spaces.

Push Enteroscopy

An examination of the upper small intestine using a long flexible camera passed through the mouth. It allows clinicians to see the lining, take samples, stop bleeding, or treat selected lesions.

Pustular Psoriasis

A group of inflammatory skin diseases marked by visible, sterile pustules on reddened skin. Forms include generalized pustular psoriasis, which affects widespread skin, and palmoplantar pustulosis, which mainly affects the palms and soles.

Pustule

A small, circumscribed, elevated skin lesion (< 1.0 cm in diameter) containing purulent exudate (pus) composed of necrotic inflammatory cells, fluid, and cellular debris within the epidermis or hair follicle. Pustules may be infectious (e.g., bacterial folliculitis, candidiasis, herpes simplex) or sterile/autoimmune (e.g., pustular psoriasis, subcorneal pustular dermatosis).

Alternate Names:
Pustules

Pustules

Plural form; see *Pustule*.

Pustulosis

A skin disorder characterized by sterile or infectious pustules, which may be localized or widespread and associated with inflammation, fever, psoriasis, drug reactions, or infection.

Putamen

A deep brain structure that helps select and smooth purposeful movements and supports learning of repeated movement habits. Damage to it can cause abnormal movements, weakness, or changes in behavior.

Putrefaction

Decomposition of body tissues after death caused mainly by bacteria and natural enzymes. It can produce color changes, swollen tissues from gas, visible veins, a strong odor, and gradual breakdown into liquid material; the rate depends on the environment.

Putrescine

A chemical with a strong unpleasant smell made when proteins break down. It is found in decaying material and is also produced in small amounts during normal cell processes; its presence alone does not diagnose disease.

PUVA

A light treatment that combines a light-sensitizing medicine called psoralen with ultraviolet-A exposure. It can treat selected skin diseases but may cause burns, eye injury, premature skin aging, and increased skin-cancer risk.

PVC

A premature ventricular contraction is an early heartbeat arising in a ventricle; occasional PVCs are common, while frequent or symptomatic beats can be associated with underlying heart disease.

PVD

Alternate name; see *Peripheral Artery Disease*.

PVD (Peripheral Vascular Disease)

Alternate name; see *Peripheral Vascular Disease*.

PVI

Alternate name; see *Pulmonary Vein Isolation*.

PVPS

Alternate name; see *Post-Vasectomy Pain Syndrome*.

P Wave

The first small wave on an ECG, showing the electrical activation of the heart's upper chambers. Its shape and timing can help identify abnormal heart rhythms, enlargement of a chamber, or problems with electrical conduction.

Pyarthrosis

Infection of a joint with pus in the joint space, usually bacterial septic arthritis, causing acute pain, swelling, restricted movement, fever, and risk of cartilage destruction.

Pycnodysostosis

A rare inherited bone disorder in which bones are unusually dense but fragile. It can cause short stature, frequent fractures, short fingers, delayed closure of skull bones, crowded teeth, and problems with the jaw.

Pyelitis

Inflammation of the renal pelvis, the funnel-shaped part of the kidney that drains urine. It is often associated with urinary infection and may cause flank pain, fever, or painful urination.

Pyelo

Pyelo is an informal shortening usually referring to pyelonephritis, an infection of the kidney and renal pelvis that can cause fever and flank pain.

Pyelogram

An image of the kidney drainage area and ureters after contrast material is given. It can show blockage, stones, narrowing, leaks, or structural changes in the urinary collecting system.

Pyelography

Imaging of the renal pelvis and ureters using contrast, by X-ray or another imaging method. It can show obstruction, stones, leaks, strictures, or structural abnormalities.

Pyelolithotomy

Surgical removal of a kidney stone through an incision into the renal pelvis. Less invasive stone treatments are often preferred when suitable.

Pyelonephritis

A bacterial infection of one or both kidneys. It often starts as a bladder infection that spreads up to a kidney. It can cause fever, chills, pain in the side or back, nausea or vomiting, and burning or frequent urination.

Pyelotomy

An incision into the renal pelvis, usually made to remove an obstruction or kidney stone.

Pylephlebitis

An infected blood clot in the large vein carrying blood from the abdominal organs to the liver. It may follow appendicitis, diverticulitis, or another abdominal infection and can cause fever, abdominal pain, jaundice, and life-threatening sepsis.

Pyloric Antrum

The pyloric antrum is the lower stomach region that grinds food and regulates its passage toward the pyloric canal and duodenum.

Pyloric Canal

The narrow passage between the pyloric antrum and the pyloric sphincter. It carries stomach contents toward the duodenum.

Pyloric Sphincter

A ring of muscle at the outlet of the stomach. It opens in a controlled way to let partly digested food enter the first part of the small intestine and helps prevent the intestine's contents from flowing backward.

Alternate Names:
Pyloric Valve; Gastric Pylorus

Pyloric Stenosis

Narrowing of the outlet between the stomach and small intestine. In infants, the usual form is thickening of the outlet muscle, causing progressively forceful, non-green vomiting. In adults, narrowing is usually acquired, for example from ulcer scarring or a tumor. It can prevent food from leaving the stomach and cause dehydration.

Pyloric Stenosis In Infants

Alternate name; see *Hypertrophic Pyloric Stenosis*.

Pyloroplasty

Surgery to widen the pylorus, the outlet of the stomach, to improve passage of stomach contents. It may be used with treatment for obstruction or selected gastric-motility disorders.

Pylorus

The distal part of the stomach leading into the duodenum.

Pyoderma

A bacterial infection of the skin that can produce pus-filled spots, crusts, open sores, or deeper inflammation. Staphylococcus and Streptococcus are common causes; infection can spread, particularly with fever, pain, or rapidly worsening redness.

Pyoderma Gangrenosum

A rare inflammatory skin disease that causes very painful ulcers, often with a dark purple edge. It may occur with bowel inflammation, arthritis, or blood disorders; injury can make it worse, so treatment differs from ordinary wound infection.

Pyogenesis

The formation of pus, a thick fluid made mainly of immune cells, dead tissue, and germs. It commonly occurs during bacterial infection or severe inflammation.

Pyogenic

Producing pus or associated with a pus-forming infection. Pyogenic infections commonly cause redness, warmth, swelling, pain, and a collection of pus, although the cause and treatment vary.

Pyogenic Granuloma

A common benign vascular proliferation (lobular capillary hemangioma) of the skin or mucous membranes that arises rapidly following minor trauma or during pregnancy ('pregnancy tumor' / granuloma gravidarum), presenting as an erythematous, smooth or lobulated, pedunculated or sessile vascular papule prone to profuse bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Lobular Capillary Hemangioma; Granuloma Gravidarum

Pyogenic Granuloma (Lobular Capillary Hemangioma)

A rapidly growing, benign vascular nodule of skin or mucosa that often follows minor trauma or occurs during pregnancy. It is bright red, friable, and prone to bleeding; treatment may include curettage, cautery, excision, or other local therapy.

Pyogenic Liver Abscess

A pyogenic liver abscess is a pus-filled infection in the liver, usually from biliary, abdominal, or bloodstream spread, causing fever, pain, and possible sepsis.

Pyometra

A collection of pus inside the uterus, usually caused by infection combined with blockage of drainage through the cervix. It may cause lower abdominal pain, fever, tenderness, or foul-smelling discharge; in older adults it can be linked to cervical narrowing or a tumor.

Pyonephrosis

Pus within the kidney's urine-collecting system, usually associated with urinary obstruction and infection. The collecting system may be dilated, and infection can extend into kidney tissue or the bloodstream. It is distinct from uncomplicated hydronephrosis, which is dilation of the collecting system without pus. Flank pain, fever, and systemic infection may occur.

Pyosalpinx

A fallopian tube that is swollen and filled with pus, usually as a complication of pelvic inflammatory disease. It may cause pelvic pain, fever, or unusual vaginal discharge, although symptoms vary. Unlike hydrosalpinx, which contains non-purulent fluid, pyosalpinx reflects infection and can damage the tube or extend into nearby tissues.

Pyostomatitis Vegetans

A rare inflammatory mouth condition causing many small yellowish pus-filled spots on red, swollen tissue, especially the inner cheeks and gums. It is strongly associated with inflammatory bowel disease and may appear before bowel symptoms.

Pyramid

A structure shaped like a pyramid. In the brain, the medullary pyramids contain nerve fibers that carry movement commands from the brain to the spinal cord; other pyramids include pyramid-shaped areas in the kidney.

Pyramidal Cell

A triangular-shaped excitatory neuron with a prominent apical dendrite, found especially in the cerebral cortex and hippocampus and involved in long-range brain signaling.

Pyramidal Tract

A major upper motor neuron descending pathway originating primarily from the precentral primary motor cortex (Brodmann area 4) and premotor areas, traversing the internal capsule, cerebral peduncles, and medullary pyramids to synapse onto lower motor neurons in the brainstem (corticobulbar tract) and spinal cord (corticospinal tract). Mediating voluntary, skilled, and fine motor movements, decussation occurs in the lower medulla; upper motor neuron lesions within the tract produce spasticity, hyperreflexia, muscle weakness, and a positive Babinski sign.

Alternate Names:
Pyramidal Tracts; Corticospinal Tract

Pyramidal Tracts

Plural form; see *Pyramidal Tract*.

Pyrazinamide

An antibiotic used with other medicines during the initial treatment of tuberculosis. It helps shorten treatment but can injure the liver or raise uric acid, so monitoring and prescribed dosing are important.

Pyrazines

A family of chemical compounds found naturally in some foods and used in flavors, medicines, and industry. Their effects on health depend on the specific compound, amount, and route of exposure.

Pyrazole

A five-membered heterocyclic organic ring compound containing two adjacent nitrogen atoms and three carbon atoms. The pyrazole ring system serves as a prominent pharmacophore in medicinal chemistry, forming the core structural foundation for non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (e.g., celecoxib), analgesics (e.g., metamizole), and target-directed kinase inhibitors.

Alternate Names:
Pyrazoles

Pyrazoles

Plural form; see *Pyrazole*.

Pyrenochaeta

A group of fungi found mainly in soil and plants that rarely infect people. When infection occurs, it usually affects tissue beneath injured skin or people with weakened immunity.

Pyrethrins

Natural insect-killing chemicals derived from chrysanthemum flowers and used in some pest-control products. Exposure can irritate skin and airways and, in large amounts, may cause vomiting, tremors, seizures, or breathing problems.

Pyrethrum

The dried flower heads of certain Chrysanthemum

species, used as a natural source of pyrethrins, insecticidal compounds that affect insect sodium channels. Pyrethrum and pyrethrins differ from synthetic pyrethroids; exposure may irritate the skin or airways and can cause toxicity with substantial exposure.

Pyrexia

Alternate medical name; see *Fever*.

Pyrexia Of Unknown Origin In A Hemodialysis Patient

Descriptive phrase for unexplained fever in a person receiving hemodialysis, not a separate disease. Infection of the dialysis access or bloodstream is an important possibility, but other causes must also be considered; see *Fever Of Unknown Origin*.

Pyridine

A nitrogen-containing ring-shaped chemical structure found in many medicines, vitamins, and biologically active substances. Pyridine groups can change how compounds dissolve, react, travel through the body, and produce medical effects.

Pyridostigmine

A medicine that increases acetylcholine, a chemical helping nerves activate muscles. It mainly treats myasthenia gravis and may cause stomach cramps, diarrhea, sweating, increased saliva, muscle twitching, or slow heartbeat.

Pyridostigmine Bromide

Pyridostigmine bromide increases communication between nerves and muscles and is used mainly for myasthenia gravis; it may cause abdominal cramps, diarrhea, or excess secretions.

Pyridoxal Phosphate

The active form of vitamin B6 used by many enzymes. It helps the body process amino acids, make certain brain chemicals and red blood cells, and maintain normal nerve function.

Pyridoxine

One form of vitamin B6, converted in the body to pyridoxal phosphate, a coenzyme for amino-acid metabolism. It is needed for processing food, making red blood cells, and supporting nerves and the immune system; deficiency can cause anemia or nerve problems, while excessive supplements can damage nerves.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin B6

Pyridoxine Deficiency

Deficiency of vitamin B6, which is needed for amino-acid metabolism, neurotransmitter synthesis, hemoglobin production, and normal nerve function. It may cause dermatitis, glossitis, anemia, seizures, neuropathy, or immune dysfunction.

Pyrimethamine

A parasite-fighting medicine that blocks folate use in certain protozoa. It is used for selected infections, often with another medicine, and can suppress bone marrow or cause serious skin reactions.

Pyrimidine

A six-membered aromatic heterocyclic organic compound containing two nitrogen atoms at positions 1 and 3 of the ring. Pyrimidines constitute the essential nitrogenous bases cytosine, thymine, and uracil in DNA and RNA. De novo synthesis begins with carbamoyl phosphate and aspartate; antimetabolite chemotherapeutics (e.g., 5-fluorouracil, capecitabine, gemcitabine) act by inhibiting pyrimidine nucleotide biosynthesis and incorporation into nucleic acids.

Alternate Names:
Pyrimidines

Pyrimidine Analog

A medicine or chemical resembling a pyrimidine nucleotide that can interfere with DNA or RNA synthesis, often for cancer or antiviral treatment.

Pyrimidine Dimer

A DNA lesion formed when adjacent pyrimidine bases bond abnormally after ultraviolet exposure,

potentially causing mutations if unrepaired.

Pyrimidine Nucleosides

Nucleosides containing cytosine, thymine, or uracil bases linked to a sugar, serving as components or precursors of DNA and RNA.

Pyrimidine Nucleotides

Genetic and energy-related building blocks containing pyrimidine bases, including cytidine, uridine, and thymidine. Cells use them to make DNA, RNA, cell membranes, and other substances needed for growth and repair.

Pyrimidines

Plural form; see *Pyrimidine*.

Pyrogen

A pyrogen is a substance that induces fever, commonly through immune signaling; bacterial endotoxin is an important example in contaminated medicines or fluids.

Pyroglyphidae

Pyroglyphidae is a mite family that includes house-dust mites whose allergens can trigger allergic rhinitis, asthma, or atopic dermatitis.

Pyromania

A mental disorder involving recurrent deliberate fire-setting, mounting tension or arousal before the act, and pleasure, gratification, or relief afterward, without a primary external motive such as financial gain, revenge, concealment of a crime, or political purpose. The behavior is not better explained by conduct disorder, mania, psychosis, or substance use.

Pyrophosphatase

An enzyme that breaks inorganic pyrophosphate into phosphate, helping drive many cellular chemical reactions forward.

Pyropoikilocytosis

A rare inherited disorder that makes red blood cells unusually small, irregular, and fragile. The cells break down easily, causing hemolytic anemia with tiredness, jaundice, pale skin, or an enlarged spleen, often beginning in infancy or childhood.

Pyroptosis

A form of controlled cell death that causes inflammation. The cell swells, breaks open, and releases signals that alert the immune system, often in response to infection or severe cell stress.

Pyrosequencing

A laboratory method for reading selected DNA sequences by detecting light produced as DNA building blocks are added. It can identify some genetic changes or microbes but is not suitable for every sequencing need.

Pyrosis

Alternate medical name; see *Heartburn*.

Pyrroles

A group of five-membered nitrogen-containing ring compounds found in heme, bile pigments, medicines, and other biologically active molecules.

Pyrrolidonecarboxylic Acid

A cyclic amino-acid derivative, also called pyroglutamic acid, found in proteins and metabolic pathways; abnormal accumulation may occur in selected metabolic or medication-related conditions.

Alternate Names:
Pyroglutamic Acid

Pyrrolnitrin

Pyrrolnitrin is an antimicrobial compound produced by some bacteria and studied for antifungal activity and biological control.

Pyruvate

A small molecule produced when cells break down glucose. Cells can use it to make more energy, convert it into other substances, or produce lactate when oxygen or energy-processing pathways are limited.

Pyruvate Carboxylase Deficiency

An inherited disorder caused by deficient pyruvate carboxylase, an enzyme needed for gluconeogenesis and other metabolic pathways. It can cause lactic acidosis, low blood glucose, poor growth, seizures, abnormal movements, developmental impairment, or liver failure.

Pyruvate Decarboxylase

Pyruvate decarboxylase is an enzyme that converts pyruvate to acetaldehyde and carbon dioxide during fermentation in some organisms.

Pyruvate Dehydrogenase

An enzyme complex that changes pyruvate, made when cells break down sugar, into acetyl-CoA for energy production. Inherited deficiency can cause excess lactic acid, poor growth, developmental problems, or neurologic disease.

Pyruvate Dehydrogenase Complex Deficiency (PDCD)

An inherited disorder in which the pyruvate dehydrogenase complex cannot efficiently convert pyruvate into acetyl-CoA. It may cause lactic acidosis, poor growth, developmental impairment, seizures, low muscle tone, ataxia, or other neurologic disease.

Pyruvate Kinase

An enzyme that helps red blood cells make energy from glucose. If it is inheritedly deficient, red cells may break down too early, causing chronic hemolytic anemia, jaundice, gallstones, tiredness, or an enlarged spleen.

Pyruvate Kinase Blood Test

A pyruvate kinase blood test measures the enzyme in red blood cells and may help evaluate pyruvate kinase deficiency, an inherited cause of hemolytic anemia.

Pyruvate Kinase Deficiency

A rare inherited condition in which red blood cells cannot make enough energy and break down early. It causes anemia of varying severity, jaundice, tiredness, gallstones, an enlarged spleen, and sometimes excess iron in the body.

Pyuria

Presence of white blood cells or pus in urine, often indicating urinary-tract inflammation or infection.

PYY

Peptide YY is a hormone released by the intestine after eating. It helps signal fullness and slows movement of food through the digestive tract; abnormal signaling is being studied in obesity and other metabolic disorders.

Q

22q11.2 Deletion Syndrome

A genetic condition caused by a missing piece of chromosome 22. It may cause heart defects, palate problems, reduced immune defenses, low calcium, distinctive facial features, learning or developmental difficulties, and increased risk of mental illness. The effects differ widely between people.

Alternate Names:
DiGeorge Syndrome Spectrum; Velocardiofacial Syndrome (VCFS); Shprintzen Syndrome; 22q11.2DS

Q Angle

The angle between a line from the anterior superior iliac spine to the center of the patella and a line from the patella to the tibial tubercle. It is used to describe knee alignment, but its measurement and value for predicting patellofemoral pain or instability are debated.

Alternate Names:
Quadriceps Angle

Q-Angle Measurement

See *Q Angle*.

Q Arm Of A Chromosome

The longer arm of a chromosome, identified by the letter q. A genetic report may use this label to show where a gene change or missing, extra, or rearranged DNA segment is located.

Q-Banding

A laboratory staining method that creates bright and dim bands on chromosomes when viewed under ultraviolet light. The pattern helps show chromosome structure and some rearrangements.

Q Fever

A bacterial infection caused by *Coxiella burnetii*, typically transmitted to humans by inhaling dust contaminated with birth fluids, urine, milk, or droppings from infected farm animals such as sheep, goats, and cattle. Acute infection commonly causes a sudden flu-like illness with high fever, severe headache, fatigue, chills, and chest or muscle pain, and can lead to pneumonia or hepatitis. A small percentage of people develop a chronic form of the infection, which can cause serious heart valve inflammation (endocarditis) years later, especially in those with preexisting heart valve problems.

Alternate Names:
Query Fever; Coxiellosis; Australian Q Fever

QRS Axis

The general direction of the heart's electrical signal as the lower chambers contract, measured on an electrocardiogram. A shifted direction can occur with changes in the heart muscle, conduction system, or strain on the heart.

QRS Complex

The group of waves on an electrocardiogram showing the electrical signal that makes the heart's lower chambers contract. An unusually wide or shaped complex may indicate a conduction problem, abnormal rhythm, or electrolyte disturbance.

QRS Duration

The time taken for the electrical signal to spread through the heart's lower chambers, measured on

an electrocardiogram. A longer-than-usual time can occur with a conduction problem or an abnormal rhythm.

Q-Switch Laser

A laser that stores energy before releasing it in brief, high-power pulses. It is used to remove tattoo pigment and treat some pigmented skin lesions; specialized Q-switched lasers are also used in eye procedures.

QTc Dispersion

The difference between the longest and shortest heart-rate-corrected QT intervals across the leads of an electrocardiogram. It has been used to estimate differences in ventricular recovery across the heart, but measurement reliability and clinical value are limited.

Alternate Names:
Interlead QT Dispersion

QT Interval

The time on an electrocardiogram representing electrical activation and recovery of the heart's lower chambers. Because heart rate changes this time, clinicians often use a corrected value when assessing rhythm risk.

QT Prolongation

An unusually long QT interval on an electrocardiogram. It may result from an inherited condition, a medicine, or abnormal body salts and can increase the risk of a rapid, dangerous rhythm that may cause fainting or cardiac arrest.

Quadrant

One of four sections used to describe a location, especially in the abdomen. The four abdominal quadrants help clinicians record where pain, tenderness, a lump, or another finding is located.

Quadrantanopia

Loss of vision in one quarter of the normal visual field, often from damage to the brain pathways carrying sight. The missing area may occur on the same side in both eyes and can affect reading, driving, walking, or safety.

Quadrantectomy

Surgery to remove one section of an organ, most often part of the breast containing a tumor plus a margin of healthy tissue. Lymph-node surgery or additional treatment may depend on tumor features and test results.

Quadrate Lobe

An area on the underside of the liver between the gallbladder fossa and the fissure for the round ligament. It lies in front of the porta hepatis and corresponds mainly to segment IVb of the functional left liver.

Alternate Names:
Lobus Quadratus Hepatis

Quadratus Femoris

A small muscle deep in the buttock that turns the thigh outward and helps draw it toward the body.

Quadratus Lumborum

A muscle along the back of the abdomen that bends the body to one side and helps steady the lowest rib during breathing.

Quadratus Plantae

A deep muscle in the sole of the foot that helps the long toe-flexing muscle pull the toes straight downward.

Alternate Names:
Flexor Accessorius

Quadriceps

The group of four muscles at the front of the thigh (rectus femoris, vastus lateralis, vastus medialis, and vastus intermedius), also called the quadriceps femoris. They straighten the knee; the rectus femoris also helps bend the hip.

Alternate Names:
Quadriceps Muscles Quadriceps Femoris Quadriceps Femoris Muscle

Quadriceps Active Test

A knee examination used to look for injury to the posterior cruciate ligament. The person tightens the thigh muscle while the knee is bent, and forward movement of a previously sagging shinbone may support the finding. The test does not confirm a tear by itself.

Alternate Names:
Active Quadriceps Drawer Test; PCL Active Contraction Sign

Quadriceps Contusion

A bruise to the muscles at the front of the thigh, usually caused by a direct blow. It can cause pain, swelling, bleeding within the muscle, and difficulty bending the knee.

Quadriceps Injury

Damage to the quadriceps muscle or tendon caused by sudden force, overuse, or direct trauma. It may cause front-of-thigh pain, bruising, weakness, or difficulty extending the knee. Severe pain, a visible or felt gap, or inability to bear weight may occur with a major tear.

Quadriceps Tendinopathy

Overuse-related pain and changes in the tendon connecting the quadriceps muscles to the kneecap. Pain is usually felt just above the kneecap and may worsen with jumping, running, or straightening the knee against resistance.

Quadriceps Tendon Rupture

A tear of the tendon connecting the quadriceps muscles to the top of the kneecap. A complete tear can cause a gap above the kneecap and prevent active knee straightening; it often follows a fall or sudden force on a bent knee.

Alternate Names:
Suprapatellar Tendon Rupture

Quadriceps Tendon Ruptures

Plural form; see *Quadriceps Tendon Rupture*.

Quadrigeminal Cistern

A cerebrospinal fluid space around the upper back part of the midbrain, beneath the back of the corpus callosum. It contains deep cerebral veins and lies next to the ambient cisterns.

Alternate Names:
Cisterna Quadrigeminalis

Quadrigeminal Plate

The dorsal roof (tectum) of the midbrain bearing four rounded sensory eminences: the paired superior colliculi (visual reflexes and saccadic eye movements) and inferior colliculi (auditory relay processing).

Alternate Names:
Tectal Plate; Lamina Tecti

Quadrilateral Space Syndrome

A neurovascular compression syndrome caused by entrapment of the axillary nerve and posterior circumflex humeral artery within the quadrilateral space (bounded by teres minor, teres major, long head of triceps, and humerus), presenting with posterior shoulder ache, paresthesias over the lateral shoulder, and deltoid weakness.

Alternate Names:
Quadrangular Space Syndrome; Axillary Nerve Compression Syndrome

Quadriparesis

Weakness affecting both arms and both legs. It may result from disease or injury to the neck spinal cord, brain, nerves, or muscles and can impair movement, breathing, and bladder or bowel control.

Quadriplegia

Paralysis affecting both arms and both legs, usually with weakness of the trunk, because of damage to the cervical spinal cord or another major nervous-system injury. It can impair breathing and bladder or bowel control.

Alternate Names:
Tetraplegia

Quadruple Screen Test

See *Quad Screen*.

Quadruplet Pregnancy

A pregnancy involving four fetuses. It has increased risks of preterm birth, restricted fetal growth, high blood pressure, metabolic problems, and illness in the pregnant person.

Quad Screen

A second-trimester maternal blood screening test measuring alpha-fetoprotein, human chorionic gonadotropin, unconjugated estriol, and inhibin A. It estimates the chance of trisomy 21, trisomy 18, and open neural-tube defects; it is a screening test, not a diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Quadruple Marker Test

Qualitative HCG Blood Test

A blood test that detects whether human chorionic gonadotropin (hCG) is present. It is commonly used to test for pregnancy but does not measure the hormone level.

Alternate Names:
Qualitative Serum Pregnancy Test; Blood hCG Screen; Qualitative Beta-hCG

Quality-Adjusted Life Year

A measure of health that combines length of life with health-related quality of life. One year in perfect health equals one quality-adjusted life year; the measure is used to compare health outcomes and treatments.

Alternate Names:
QALY

Quality Of Life

A person's experience of physical health, emotional well-being, relationships, independence, and ability to do meaningful activities. Illness and treatment may affect these areas differently for each person.

Quantitative Bence-Jones Protein Test

A urine test measuring abnormal light-chain proteins made by some plasma-cell cancers. It can help diagnose or monitor disorders such as multiple myeloma, but results are interpreted with blood tests and other findings.

Quantitative Computed Tomography

A CT scan that measures bone density while showing bone structure. It can help assess osteoporosis, unusual bone loss, or fracture risk when standard bone-density testing is unsuitable or more detail is needed.

Quantitative HCG Blood Test

A blood test that measures the amount of human chorionic gonadotropin (hCG). It can help assess early pregnancy, possible ectopic pregnancy or miscarriage, and some pregnancy-related or germ-cell tumors.

Alternate Names:
Quantitative Beta-hCG; Serum hCG Level

Quantitative Immunoglobulins

A blood test measuring the main classes of antibodies. Low levels may suggest an immune deficiency, while high or uneven levels may occur with infection, inflammation, liver disease, or some blood cancers; findings are interpreted with other clinical information.

Quantitative Nephelometry Test

A laboratory test that estimates the amount of selected proteins by measuring how much light they scatter. It can measure antibodies, complement proteins, and other proteins involved in immune, kidney, or blood disorders.

Quantitative PET

Analysis of a PET scan that estimates how much radioactive tracer is taken up by tissue. Standardized measurements can help compare disease activity or treatment response, but results are affected by the tracer, timing, blood sugar, and scanning method.

Quantitative Sensory Testing

A set of tests that measures a person's responses to sensations such as vibration, temperature, and pain. It helps assess sensory nerve function but does not diagnose nerve damage by itself.

Alternate Names:
QST; Psychophysical Sensory Threshold Assay

Quarantine

Temporary separation or movement restrictions for people exposed to an infectious disease while monitoring whether they become ill. It differs from isolation, which separates people who are already infected.

Quartan Fever

A fever pattern in which attacks recur about every 72 hours, classically seen with the malaria parasite Plasmodium malariae. Fever timing alone cannot diagnose malaria, which is identified with laboratory testing.

Queckenstedt Test

A historical test for blockage of the spinal fluid pathway, performed during lumbar puncture by briefly compressing the neck veins and observing the cerebrospinal-fluid pressure response. It is now rarely used because imaging such as MRI can assess the spine without this maneuver.

Alternate Names:
Queckenstedt's Sign; Queckenstedt-Stookey Test; Jugular Venous Spinal Manometry Test

Queensland Tick Typhus

A spotted-fever infection caused by the bacterium *Rickettsia australis* and spread by infected ticks in eastern Australia. It commonly causes fever and headache and may cause a rash or a dark scab at the bite site. Several *Ixodes* tick species can carry the bacterium.

Alternate Names:
QTT; Australian Tick Typhus

Quellung Reaction

A laboratory reaction in which antibodies bind to a bacterium's capsule, making the capsule appear enlarged under a microscope. It can help identify encapsulated bacteria such as *Streptococcus pneumoniae*.

Alternate Names:
Neufeld Quellung Phenomenon; Capsular Swelling Test

Quetiapine Fumarate

A form of quetiapine, a medicine used for schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and selected depression treatment. It can cause sleepiness, dizziness on standing, weight or blood-sugar changes, and movement problems.

Quickening

The first fetal movements perceived by the pregnant person, often felt as a flutter or light tapping. Most people first notice movement around 18–20 weeks of pregnancy; it may be noticed earlier in a later pregnancy and may be harder to feel when the placenta is on the front wall of the uterus.

Quick Relievers

Asthma medicines used for rapid relief of symptoms such as wheezing and breathlessness. Some relax airway muscles; others combine this action with an inhaled corticosteroid. The medicines used vary among asthma regimens.

Alternate Names:
Quick-Relief Medicines; Reliever Medicines; Rescue Medicines

Quick Sequential Organ Failure Assessment

A rapid bedside screening tool used by healthcare providers to identify adult patients with suspected infection who may be developing sepsis and face a high risk of life-threatening complications. It evaluates three simple clinical signs: a drop in blood pressure (low systolic pressure), rapid breathing, and altered mental clarity or confusion. A positive score alerts medical teams that urgent evaluation and closer monitoring are needed.

Alternate Names:
qSOFA; Quick SOFA Score

Quick Test

An older name for a one-stage prothrombin-time test, which measures how long blood takes to clot after tissue factor is added. It is the basis of modern prothrombin-time testing.

Alternate Names:
Quick Prothrombin Time; One-Stage Prothrombin Assay

Quinalphos

A poisonous insecticide that disrupts nerve-signal control. Significant exposure can cause sweating, excess saliva, vomiting, muscle twitching, weakness, seizures, breathing failure, or death.

Quinapril

Quinapril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension and heart failure; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

Quincke Edema

Older term; see *Angioedema*.

Alternate Names:
Angioneurotic Edema

Quincke Needle

A spinal needle with a sharp, oblique cutting tip and a stylet, used for lumbar puncture or spinal anesthesia. Compared with pencil-point needles, cutting needles are generally associated with a higher risk of post-dural puncture headache; risk also depends on needle gauge and technique.

Quincke Pulse

A classical peripheral physical finding of severe chronic aortic regurgitation (aortic insufficiency), characterized by visible rhythmic alternating blanching and capillary flushing in the subungual nail bed accentuated by gentle compression of the distal edge of the fingernail. It results from the hyperdynamic wide pulse pressure and rapid diastolic runoff (water-hammer or Corrigan pulse hemodynamics) inherent to severe valvular aortic regurgitation.

Alternate Names:
Quincke's Sign; Capillary Pulse; Subungual Capillary Pulsation

Quincke Pulse Sign

See *Quincke Pulse*.

Quincke's Disease

Older term; see *Angioedema*.

Quincke's Edema

Older term; see *Angioedema*.

Quincke's Pulse

See *Quincke Pulse*.

Quincke's Sign

See *Quincke Pulse*.

Quinidine

A heart-rhythm medicine that changes electrical conduction in the heart. It is used selectively because it can cause dangerous abnormal rhythms, low blood pressure, low platelets, diarrhea, or other serious side effects.

Quinidine Syncope

Fainting caused by a dangerous heart rhythm associated with quinidine, usually torsades de pointes due to QT-interval prolongation. In severe cases, the rhythm can lead to cardiac arrest.

Quinine

A medicine derived from cinchona bark that can treat selected malaria infections. It is used less often because safer options are available and it can cause low blood sugar, ringing in the ears, blood-cell problems, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Quinine Amblyopia

An older term for visual loss caused by quinine toxicity. It may affect both eyes and narrow the visual field; severe injury can cause lasting visual impairment.

Alternate Names:
Quinine Amaurosis

Quinolone

A class of antibiotics that inhibit bacterial DNA gyrase and topoisomerase IV; fluoroquinolones are the major clinically used subgroup. Serious adverse effects particularly associated with systemic

fluoroquinolones include tendon injury, peripheral neuropathy, QT prolongation, and severe antibiotic-associated diarrhea.

Alternate Names:
Quinolone Antibiotics

Quinolone-Induced Tendinopathy

Tendon pain or damage associated mainly with fluoroquinolone antibiotics such as ciprofloxacin or levofloxacin. The Achilles tendon is often affected, and tendon rupture can occur; risk is higher in older adults and people taking corticosteroids.

Quinsy

A painful collection of pus (abscess) that forms in the tissues next to one of the tonsils in the back of the throat, usually as a complication of severe or untreated bacterial tonsillitis. The infection causes intense one-sided throat pain, difficulty and pain when swallowing, severe swelling that can push the tonsil and uvula toward the opposite side, fever, difficulty opening the mouth (trismus), and a muffled voice. If left untreated, the swelling can potentially obstruct breathing.

Alternate Names:
Peritonsillar Abscess; PTA

Quinupristin-Dalfopristin

An intravenous antibiotic combination used rarely for selected serious infections caused by resistant gram-positive bacteria. It can cause muscle or joint pain, liver problems, infusion reactions, and medicine interactions.

Quit Smoking

Alternate name; see *Smoking Cessation*.

Quorum Sensing

Communication among bacteria using chemical signals that build up as the bacterial population grows. The signals can coordinate group behaviors such as biofilm formation and production of factors that cause disease.

Quotidian Fever

A fever pattern in which fever rises or attacks occur about every 24 hours. It can occur with malaria and other infections, but the timing of fever alone does not identify the cause.

Quotidian Malaria

A malaria fever pattern with paroxysms about every 24 hours, associated especially with *Plasmodium knowlesi*, which has a 24-hour blood-stage cycle. Overlapping parasite broods can produce a similar pattern with other species; fever periodicity alone does not identify the species.

Alternate Names:
24-Hour Malarial Paroxysm; Daily Malarial Fever

Q Wave

A downward movement that may begin the electrical pattern of a heartbeat on an electrocardiogram. It can be normal in some recording positions or suggest previous heart-muscle injury, depending on its size and location.

Alternate Names:
Q Waves

R

Rabeprazole

A medicine that greatly reduces acid made by the stomach. It treats reflux and ulcers and may be combined with antibiotics for Helicobacter pylori infection; possible effects include headache, diarrhea, and rarely low magnesium or bowel infection.

Rabies

A rare, severe, and almost invariably fatal viral infection of the brain and nervous system transmitted to humans through the saliva of an infected mammal, most often via a bite or scratch. Once the rabies virus enters the body, it travels along nerves to the spinal cord and brain, where it causes acute, progressive inflammation (encephalitis). Early symptoms include fever, headache, and tingling or numbness at the bite site, rapidly progressing to anxiety, confusion, agitation, painful throat spasms when attempting to swallow liquids (hydrophobia), paralysis, and coma.

Alternate Names:
Hydrophobia; Lyssa; Rabic Encephalitis

Rabies Vaccination

Immunization used before or after exposure to reduce the risk of rabies. Post-exposure management also includes wound care and, when indicated, rabies immunoglobulin.

Rabies Virus

The virus that causes rabies, a usually fatal viral infection of the central nervous system transmitted most often through the saliva of an infected animal.

Rachitic Rosary

A row of bead-like swellings where the ribs meet their cartilage, seen in some children with rickets. The swellings result from abnormal bone growth and mineralization.

Alternate Names:
Beaded Ribs; Costochondral Rosary

Radial

Relating to the radius bone or the thumb side of the forearm and hand. The word can also describe structures arranged like spokes spreading from a central point.

Radial Artery

An artery that runs along the thumb side of the forearm to the wrist and hand. Its pulse can be felt at the wrist, and it supplies blood to the forearm and parts of the hand.

Radial Artery Access

Use of the radial artery at the wrist as the entry route for cardiac catheterization or another endovascular procedure.

Radial Artery Thrombosis

A blood clot blocking the artery on the thumb side of the forearm, sometimes after an arterial catheter or injury. It may cause a painful, pale, cold, numb, or weak hand and can threaten hand circulation.

Radial Club Hand

A birth-related difference in which the thumb-side forearm bone is small or absent and the hand bends toward the thumb side. The thumb may also be un-

derdeveloped, and treatment depends on movement, function, and associated conditions.

Radial Head Subluxation

A common elbow injury in young children, often called nursemaid's elbow, in which the radial head slips partly out from beneath the band of tissue that holds it in place. It often follows a sudden pull on the arm; the child may stop using the arm but usually has little swelling. A trained clinician can put the bone back in place.

Alternate Names:
Nursemaid's Elbow; Pulled Elbow; Annular Ligament Displacement

Radial Nerve

A major nerve of the arm that helps straighten the elbow, wrist, and fingers and carries feeling from part of the back of the hand. Injury can cause wrist drop, finger weakness, or numbness.

Radial Nerve Dysfunction

Impaired function of the radial nerve causing weakness of wrist or finger extension and sensory changes over part of the posterior arm or hand; causes include compression, trauma, and systemic neuropathy.

Radial Nerve Palsy

Dysfunction of the radial nerve causing weakness of wrist and finger extension, often producing wrist drop, with sensory loss over part of the back of the hand in some cases.

Radial Scar

A benign breast lesion with a scar-like pattern of tissue that may resemble cancer on imaging. It may be associated with a small increase in breast cancer risk.

Alternate Names:
Complex Sclerosing Lesion

Radial Tunnel Syndrome

A pain syndrome attributed to compression or irritation of the posterior interosseous branch of the radial nerve in the proximal forearm. It causes aching pain near the outer elbow or upper forearm, usually without objective motor weakness or sensory loss; weakness suggests another or additional nerve disorder.

Radial Vein

Veins running alongside the radial artery on the thumb side of the forearm. They drain blood from the forearm and join other deep veins near the elbow.

Radiation

Energy traveling as particles or electromagnetic waves, including X-rays, gamma rays, ultraviolet light, and radio waves. Depending on its type and amount, radiation can diagnose disease, treat cancer, or damage living tissue.

Radiation Biology

The study of how radiation affects cells, tissues, organisms, and populations. It examines injury, repair, mutations, cancer risk, treatment effects, and protective measures after exposure to ionizing or nonionizing radiation.

Radiation Contamination

Radioactive material on or inside a person, object, surface, or body site where it is not intended to be. External contamination can spread to other people or surfaces; internal contamination occurs when radioactive material is inhaled, swallowed, or enters through a wound.

Radiation Dosage

See *Radiation Dose*.

Radiation Dose

A measure of radiation delivered to or absorbed by matter. Absorbed dose measures energy deposited per unit mass and is expressed in grays; equivalent and effective dose account for radiation type and tissue sensitivity and are expressed in sieverts. In medical imaging, dose depends on the procedure, equipment, and patient and is optimized to limit exposure while obtaining the needed information.

Radiation Emergency

An event involving actual or suspected harmful radiation exposure or contamination that requires urgent protective and medical measures.

Radiation Enteritis

Inflammation or injury of the small or large intestine after radiation treatment. Early symptoms may include diarrhea, cramps, nausea, or urgency; months or years later, scarring can cause narrowing, poor absorption, bleeding, or blockage.

Radiation Exposure

Contact with ionizing or non-ionizing radiation from medical imaging, treatment, sunlight, workplaces, or other sources. The possible harm depends mainly on the type, dose, body area, and duration of exposure.

Radiation Fibrosis

Long-term thickening and stiffening of tissue caused by radiation injury, sometimes appearing months or years after treatment. It can affect skin, lungs, bowel, or other organs and may cause pain, reduced movement, or shortness of breath.

Radiation Field

The area and distribution of radiation delivered during imaging or radiation treatment. In therapy, its size, shape, direction, and dose are planned to cover the target while limiting exposure to nearby healthy tissue.

Radiation-Induced Angiosarcoma

A rare, fast-growing cancer of blood-vessel lining cells that develops years after radiation in previously treated tissue. It may appear as a bruise, purple patch, swelling, or lump in the treated area.

Radiation Leukemia

Leukemia associated with prior exposure to ionizing radiation. The risk depends on the dose and exposure circumstances, and the disease may develop years later.

Radiation Monitoring

Measurement of radiation levels or individual exposure using devices such as personal dosimeters and area monitors.

Radiation Necrosis

Permanent death of tissue caused by radiation injury, often developing months or years after treatment. In the brain it may cause headache, seizures, swelling, weakness, or speech and vision problems and can resemble returning cancer on scans.

Radiation Oncologist

A doctor who plans and oversees radiation treatment for cancer and selected noncancerous conditions. They choose treatment areas and doses, coordinate care, monitor side effects, and adjust therapy during treatment.

Radiation Oncology

The branch of oncology that uses ionizing radiation to treat malignant tumors and selected benign conditions. Radiation oncologists plan and oversee treatment delivered externally or from radioactive sources placed in or near tissue. Treatment may aim to cure, control tumor growth, reduce recurrence, or relieve symptoms.

Radiation Physics

The study of how radiation is produced, travels, interacts with tissues, and is measured. It supports medical imaging, radiation treatment, dose calculation, and protection from unnecessary exposure.

Radiation Pneumonitis

Inflammation of lung tissue occurring weeks or months after radiation to the chest. It may cause dry cough, fever, breathlessness, or low oxygen and can later leave permanent scarring.

Radiation Poisoning

Illness caused by substantial exposure to ionizing radiation, potentially producing skin injury, bone-marrow suppression, gastrointestinal symptoms, or organ failure.

Radiation Pregnancy Screening

Assessment of pregnancy status before a procedure involving ionizing radiation or radioactive material when pregnancy is possible. Its relevance depends on the procedure and potential fetal exposure.

Radiation Proctitis

Inflammation and injury of the rectum after pelvic radiation therapy, causing rectal pain, urgency, diarrhea, mucus, or bleeding.

Radiation Protection

The practice of keeping radiation exposure as low as reasonably achievable while obtaining the required diagnostic or therapeutic result. It relies on justification, optimization, time reduction, distance, shielding, and appropriate contamination control.

Radiation Recall

Inflammation in an area previously treated with radiation that returns after a later trigger, often a medicine. The reaction may affect the skin or an internal lining.

Radiation-Recall Dermatitis

A skin form of *Radiation Recall*, in which a previously irradiated area becomes inflamed after a later trigger, often a medicine.

Radiation Safety

Measures used to prevent unintended or unnecessary exposure to ionizing radiation during imaging, treatment, research, or work with radioactive materials.

Radiation Sickness

Acute illness caused by a high dose of ionizing radiation to much of the body. It can damage the bone marrow, digestive tract, skin, or other tissues; severity depends on the dose and exposed body area.

Radiation Therapy

See *Radiotherapy*.

Radiation Tolerance

The amount of radiation that a tissue or organ can receive before injury becomes likely. It varies with the tissue, dose, treatment schedule, and previous radiation.

Radical Cystectomy

Surgery to remove the urinary bladder, usually for muscle-invasive or high-risk bladder cancer. Because urine can no longer leave through the bladder, another route for urine drainage is created.

Radical Cystoprostatectomy

Surgery to remove the urinary bladder and prostate, usually to treat invasive bladder cancer. Nearby lymph nodes and other tissues may also be removed, and a new route for urine drainage is created.

Radical Hysterectomy

An operation that removes the uterus and cervix together with surrounding parametrial tissues and the upper vagina, usually with pelvic lymph-node assessment or removal. It is used mainly for selected invasive cervical cancers and is more extensive than a simple or total hysterectomy.

Radical Lymphadenectomy

Extensive surgery to remove lymph nodes and nearby tissue to look for or treat cancer spread. It may provide important staging information but can cause pain, nerve or vessel injury, and long-term swelling from lymph-fluid blockage.

Radical Mastectomy

Radical mastectomy removes the breast, chest muscles, and many underarm lymph nodes; it is now rarely used because less extensive cancer surgery is often effective.

Radical Nephrectomy

Radical nephrectomy removes an entire kidney and sometimes nearby tissues, usually to treat a kidney tumor.

Radical Prostatectomy

Surgery to remove the whole prostate gland and usually the nearby seminal vesicles, most often to treat prostate cancer that has not spread widely. The urinary passage is rejoined to the bladder; possible effects include urine leakage, erection problems, bleeding, and infection.

Radicular Cyst

A cyst that forms at the root tip of a dead or severely infected tooth, usually because of long-standing inflammation around the tooth root.

Radiculitis

Irritation or inflammation of a nerve root where it leaves the spine. It can cause pain spreading along an arm or leg, tingling, numbness, weakness, or changed reflexes because of a disk problem, narrowing, infection, or other disease.

Radiculopathy

Dysfunction of a spinal nerve root, usually from disc herniation, narrowing, or inflammation. It may cause shooting pain, tingling, numbness, weakness, or altered reflexes along the affected nerve pathway.

Radioactive Iodine

A radioactive form of iodine taken up by thyroid cells. It is used to image the thyroid or destroy overactive thyroid tissue and selected thyroid cancer cells; radiation-safety precautions are needed after some treatments.

Radioactive Iodine Ablation

Treatment using radioactive iodine to destroy remaining thyroid tissue or selected thyroid cancer cells after surgery. Thyroid cells absorb the iodine; the decision depends on cancer type, spread, recurrence risk, and the person's overall health.

Radioactive Iodine Uptake

A test measuring the percentage of administered radioactive iodine taken up by the thyroid over time, used to evaluate hyperthyroidism and selected thyroid disorders.

Radioactive Iodine Uptake Test

See *Radioactive Iodine Uptake*.

Radioactivity

Energy released when unstable atoms change into more stable forms. The energy may be particles or rays and can be used in medical imaging or treatment, but enough exposure can damage living tissue.

Radioallergosorbent Test

An older blood test that used a radioactive label to measure IgE antibodies to a specific allergen. It has largely been replaced by newer specific-IgE tests; a positive result shows sensitization, not necessarily clinical allergy.

Alternate Names:
RAST

Radiobiology

See *Radiation Biology*.

Radiocarpal Joint

The main wrist joint between the forearm bone on the thumb side and several wrist bones. It allows the hand to bend forward, backward, and from side to side and may be injured by falls or arthritis.

Radiochemical Purity

The proportion of a radioactive medicine present in the intended chemical form. Unwanted forms can make a scan less accurate, send radiation to the wrong tissues, or reduce treatment effectiveness.

Radiochemistry

The chemistry of radioactive substances and compounds. In medicine it includes making and labeling radiopharmaceuticals, studying radioactive decay, separating products, and checking radiochemical purity and safety.

Radiocontrast

A substance given during an imaging test to make selected tissues, blood vessels, or body spaces easier to see. Depending on the agent, allergic reactions, kidney injury, or leakage-related damage may occur.

Radiodermatitis

Skin injury caused by ionizing radiation, such as radiation treatment. It may cause redness, dryness, itching, hair loss, peeling, sores, or long-term skin changes; severity depends on the dose, treatment area, and repeated exposure.

Radioembolisation

Alternate name; see *Radioembolization*.

Radioembolization

A treatment that delivers tiny radioactive beads through an artery supplying a liver tumor. The beads lodge near the tumor and deliver radiation to it; suitability depends on liver function, tumor extent, and blood flow.

Radio-Femoral Delay

A delay in the femoral pulse compared with the wrist pulse. It is a classic sign of narrowing of the aorta, especially coarctation, and can also occur with severe blockage of the aortoiliac arteries.

Radiofrequency

Electromagnetic energy in the radio-frequency range, used in communication and in selected medical tests and treatments. Medical uses include heating tissue or delivering energy during procedures.

Alternate Names:
Radiofrequency Energy; RF Radiation

Radiofrequency Ablation

A procedure that uses high-frequency electrical energy to heat and destroy selected tissue, often under imaging guidance.

Radiofrequency Ablation For Chronic Pain

A procedure that applies radiofrequency energy to selected sensory nerves or other targets to interrupt pain signaling for a limited period in carefully selected chronic pain conditions.

Radiograph

An image made with X-rays. Dense structures such as bone appear light, while air appears dark and soft tissues appear in shades of gray. Radiographs are used to assess bones, the chest, teeth, and selected abdominal or foreign-body problems; they use a small amount of radiation.

Alternate Names:
X-Ray; Roentgenogram; Radiographic Image

Radiographer

A trained professional who performs diagnostic imaging examinations or delivers radiotherapy, depending on specialty and jurisdiction.

Radiography

Creation of images using X-rays. It is useful for bones, chest disease, dental structures, and many other conditions; radiation exposure is kept as low as reasonably achievable.

Radioimmunoassay

A laboratory test that uses an antibody and a small radioactive label to measure a hormone, medicine, or protein in a sample. It can be very sensitive but is often replaced by newer nonradioactive tests.

Radioimmunoguided Surgery

Surgery in which a radioactive tracer attached to an antibody helps the surgeon locate tissue carrying a particular marker, often tumor tissue. Special equipment detects the tracer during the operation.

Radioimmunotherapy

Treatment that attaches a radioactive substance to an antibody so the antibody carries radiation toward cells with a particular marker, often cancer cells. Radiation can still affect nearby normal tissue and cause side effects.

Radioiodine

A radioactive form of iodine used in nuclear medicine to image or treat thyroid tissue. It is taken up by thyroid cells; precautions are needed to limit radiation exposure to others.

Radioiodine Therapy

Treatment using radioactive iodine, which is taken up mainly by thyroid cells to destroy overactive thyroid tissue or selected thyroid cancer cells. It requires individualized dosing and temporary radiation-safety precautions; pregnancy and breastfeeding are contraindications.

Radioisotope

An unstable form of an element that emits radiation as it decays. Radioisotopes are used in medical imaging, diagnosis, and selected treatments.

Alternate Names:
Radioactive Isotope

Radioligand Therapy

A cancer treatment in which a radioactive atom is attached to a molecule that binds a target on cancer cells. The molecule carries radiation to cells with that target; use depends on the cancer and the target's presence.

Radiologic Health

The safe use of medical imaging and radiation-based treatment to protect patients, workers, and the public from unnecessary ionizing radiation while preserving clinical benefit. Safety measures include appropriate justification, shielding, and dose optimization.

Radiologic-Pathologic Correlation

Comparison of scan findings with tissue examined under a microscope to determine whether a sample explains an abnormal area. A mismatch means the imaging and tissue findings are discordant.

Radiologic Response

The change seen on medical scans after treatment, such as shrinkage, disappearance, stability, growth, or new lesions. Standard measurement rules help classify the response, but scans do not always show the full biological effect.

Radiologic Technologist

A trained health professional who performs selected medical-imaging examinations and helps protect patients from unnecessary radiation exposure.

Radiologist

A doctor trained to interpret medical images and sometimes perform image-guided procedures. Radiologists evaluate X-rays, ultrasound, CT, MRI, and other scans to diagnose disease, guide treatment, or obtain tissue samples.

Radiology

The medical field that uses images to find and monitor disease and guide procedures. Radiologists interpret X-rays, ultrasound, CT, MRI, and other scans and may perform image-guided biopsies, drainages, injections, or treatments.

Radiology-Patient Identification

Verification of the correct patient, examination, body site, indication, pregnancy status when relevant, allergies, renal function, and prior imaging before image acquisition or intervention. It is a core diagnostic and procedural safety step.

Radiology Report

A written explanation of an imaging study, describing why it was done, the important findings, and their possible meaning.

Radiolucent

Describing a material that lets more X-rays pass through and therefore appears darker on an X-ray or CT image. Air is highly radiolucent; some stones, foreign bodies, and abnormal tissues can also have this appearance.

Radiomimetic

Radiomimetic describes a chemical or treatment that produces cellular or DNA damage resembling the effects of ionizing radiation.

Radionuclide

An unstable atomic nuclide characterized by excess nuclear energy that spontaneously decays toward stability through the emission of ionizing ra-

diation (such as alpha particles, beta particles, or gamma photons). In medicine, radionuclides (e.g., technetium-99m, iodine-123, iodine-131, fluorine-18) are coupled to specific pharmaceutical ligands for diagnostic imaging (single-photon emission computed tomography [SPECT] and positron emission tomography [PET]) or utilized for targeted internal radiopharmaceutical therapy (e.g., lutetium-177 dotatate, radioiodine ablation of thyroid tissue).

Alternate Names:
Radionuclides; Radioactive Isotope; Radioisotope

Radionuclide Angiography

An imaging test in which a small amount of radioactive tracer is used to follow blood flow through the heart or blood vessels. A camera detects the tracer and produces information about circulation or heart pumping.

Radionuclide Cystogram

A nuclear medicine examination that tracks radiolabeled urine to detect vesicoureteral reflux or evaluate bladder emptying.

Radionuclide Generator

A device that produces a short-lived radioactive substance from a longer-lasting radioactive substance. It supplies certain tracers for nuclear scans or treatment when needed and must be operated under strict safety and quality controls.

Radionuclide Heart Scan

A nuclear medicine study that uses a radioactive tracer to evaluate myocardial blood flow, heart muscle viability, or ventricular function.

Radionuclide Imaging

A scan that uses a small amount of radioactive tracer to show the structure or activity of an organ. A camera detects the tracer, helping evaluate blood flow, bone, thyroid, kidney, heart, or cancer-related changes.

Radionuclide Imaging Or Scan

A scan that detects radiation from a small amount of radioactive tracer given to a person. The tracer collects in selected organs or tissues, allowing clinicians to examine blood flow, structure, or function and identify some diseases.

Alternate Names:
Scintigraphy; Nuclear Medicine Scan; Gamma Scan

Radionuclides

Plural form; see *Radionuclide*.

Radionuclide Studies

Diagnostic studies that use a small amount of radioactive tracer and specialized imaging equipment to assess blood flow, organ function, or tissue viability.

Radionuclide Therapy

Treatment that delivers radiation from inside the body using a radioactive substance directed toward selected tissue. It can treat some thyroid diseases, cancers, or painful bone lesions. The medicine, dose, precautions, and side effects depend on the target and the person's kidney, blood, and overall health.

Radionuclidic Purity

The proportion of radioactivity in a preparation that comes from the intended radioactive atom rather than unwanted radioactive contaminants. High purity helps ensure the expected scan or treatment and limits unnecessary radiation to other tissues.

Radio-Opaque

Blocking X-rays and appearing relatively white on a radiograph; radiopaque is the modern spelling.

Radiopaque

Describing a material that attenuates X-rays strongly and therefore appears relatively white on a radiograph or CT image. Bone, metal, and some contrast agents are radiopaque.

Radiopharmaceutical

A medicine containing a small amount of radioactive material. It can show how an organ or tissue works on a scan or deliver radiation to selected diseased cells; its distribution determines the information or

treatment it provides.

Radiopharmaceutical Extravasation

Leakage of a radioactive medicine from the vein into nearby tissue during an injection. It can reduce the accuracy of a scan and, with treatment doses, injure local tissue; staff assess and document the event.

Radiopharmaceutical Labeling Kit

A prepared set of sterile ingredients used to attach a radioactive atom to a substance that travels to a particular organ or follows a body process. The finished product is tested before it is given for imaging.

Radiopharmaceutical Quality Control

Testing to verify a radioactive medicine's identity, radionuclidic and radiochemical purity, pH, and other required release specifications. Sterility and endotoxin testing or controls apply according to the preparation and applicable standards.

Radiopharmacy

The preparation, testing, storage, and dispensing of medicines containing radioactive materials. Radiopharmacy requires accurate activity measurement, cleanliness, sterility checks, quality control, safe handling, and protection of workers and patients.

Radioprotective Agent

A medicine or substance intended to reduce injury to healthy tissue from ionizing radiation. It may limit chemical damage or support cell repair, but its benefit and risks depend on the type, dose, and treatment setting.

Radio-Radial Delay

A difference in timing or strength between the right and left wrist pulses. It can suggest obstruction of an artery supplying one arm, but the finding alone does not identify the cause.

Radiosensitization

Making cells more vulnerable to radiation damage. Some medicines or treatments are combined with radiotherapy to increase damage to cancer cells, while treatment planning aims to limit harm to nearby healthy tissue.

Radiosurgery

Radiosurgery delivers highly focused radiation to a small target, usually in the brain or body, without making a conventional surgical incision.

Radiotherapy

Treatment using high-energy radiation to damage and control abnormal cells, especially cancer. It may be given from outside or inside the body and can cause temporary or lasting effects in nearby healthy tissue.

Radiotherapy Bolus

A layer of material placed on the skin during selected radiation treatments so more radiation reaches the skin surface. It is positioned carefully to deliver the planned dose to the target area.

Radiotherapy Dosage

Radiotherapy dosage is the amount of ionizing radiation prescribed for a treatment target, usually divided into carefully planned fractions.

Radiotracer

A small amount of radioactive material attached to a substance that travels through a specific body process. A scanner detects where it goes, helping show blood flow, organ function, bone activity, or selected disease-related changes.

Radioulnar Joint

A joint between the radius and ulna bones of the forearm. It allows the hand and forearm to turn palm-up and palm-down.

Radium

A naturally radioactive chemical element that releases penetrating radiation as it breaks down. Internal exposure can damage bone and other tissues and increase cancer risk.

Radium-223

A radioactive medicine that behaves like calcium and collects in areas of increased bone activity. It is used for selected prostate cancers that have spread to bone and may cause low blood counts or other side effects.

Radius

The forearm bone on the thumb side. It joins the elbow and wrist and rotates around the ulna, allowing the palm to turn up or down.

Radius Fracture

A break in the radius, one of the two bones of the forearm, often occurring near the wrist after a fall onto an outstretched hand.

Radon

A naturally occurring radioactive gas that can accumulate indoors and increase lung-cancer risk when inhaled over time.

Ragged Red Fibers

An appearance seen in a muscle biopsy when abnormal mitochondria build up around muscle fibers. It supports the diagnosis of some mitochondrial muscle diseases but is not specific to one condition. The biopsy result must be interpreted with symptoms, blood tests, genetic testing, and other findings.

Alternate Names:
RRF; Ragged-Red Muscle Fibers

Raised Hemidiaphragm

A raised hemidiaphragm is elevation of one side of the diaphragm, caused by abdominal pressure, lung volume loss, phrenic-nerve dysfunction, or diaphragmatic disease.

Rale

An older auscultatory term denoting a crackle, an intermittent, non-musical, explosive adventitious breath sound heard during auscultation of the chest, produced by the sudden explosive opening of collapsed small peripheral airways or air bubbling through fluid in alveoli and bronchoalveolar spaces. Divided into fine crackles (high-pitched, short duration, characteristic of interstitial pulmonary fibrosis or congestive heart failure) and coarse crackles (low-pitched, longer duration, seen with bronchitis or pneumonia).

Alternate Names:
Rales; Crackle; Crackles; Crepitations

Râle

Older term; see *Crackles*.

Rales

Plural form; see *Rale*.

Raloxifene

A medicine that acts like estrogen in bones but blocks some estrogen effects elsewhere. It may reduce spine fractures and selected breast-cancer risk after menopause, but can increase blood-clot risk.

Raloxifene Hydrochloride

See *Raloxifene*.

Raltegravir Potassium

Raltegravir potassium is an HIV integrase inhibitor used with other antiretroviral medicines to suppress HIV replication.

Raltitrexed

A chemotherapy medicine used for some colorectal cancers. It blocks a cell process needed to make DNA, slowing the growth of cancer cells; possible effects include diarrhea, mouth sores, low blood counts, tiredness, and liver problems.

Ramipril

Ramipril is an angiotensin-converting-enzyme inhibitor used for hypertension, heart failure, and cardiovascular risk reduction; cough, hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, angioedema, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

Rampant Caries

Severe tooth decay affecting many teeth or surfaces at once. It may be linked with frequent sugar, dry

mouth, vomiting, poor oral hygiene, limited dental care, medicines, or other health problems.

Ramsay Hunt Syndrome

Shingles affecting a nerve in the face near the ear. It can cause painful blisters in or around one ear or in the mouth, along with weakness on the same side of the face. Hearing loss, ringing, or dizziness may also occur, and sometimes no rash appears.

Alternate Names:
Herpes Zoster Oticus; Ramsay Hunt Syndrome Type II

Ramsay Hunt Syndrome Type I

A rare neurological disorder characterized by progressive myoclonus epilepsy, intentional cerebellar tremor, progressive ataxia, and mild cognitive decline. Historically termed dyssynergia cerebellaris myoclonica; distinct from Ramsay Hunt syndrome type II (herpes zoster oticus).

Alternate Names:
Dyssynergia Cerebellaris Myoclonica; Dentatorubral Tremor Syndrome

Ramsay Hunt Syndrome Type II

Alternate name; see *Ramsay Hunt Syndrome*.

Ramucirumab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks vascular endothelial growth factor receptor 2 and is used in selected advanced cancers, including gastric, colorectal, lung, and liver cancers.

Ramus

A ramus is a branch-like extension of a bone, nerve, artery, or other structure, such as the mandibular ramus.

Random Allocation

Assignment of participants to study groups by chance to reduce selection bias and balance known and unknown factors.

Randomised Controlled Trial

A study in which participants are assigned by chance to interventions or controls and outcomes are compared.

Randomization Validation

Checking that a clinical trial's assignment process truly places participants into study groups by chance and is implemented as planned. This helps reduce selection bias and protects the reliability of comparisons between treatments.

Randomized Controlled Trial

An experimental study in which participants are assigned by chance to different interventions or a control condition and followed for specified outcomes.

Range Of Motion

The amount a joint can move in different directions. It may be measured by a healthcare professional or by the person moving alone; pain, swelling, stiffness, weakness, injury, or a shortened muscle can reduce it.

Ranibizumab

An intravitreal monoclonal antibody fragment that inhibits vascular endothelial growth factor and treats neovascular macular degeneration, diabetic macular edema, retinal vein occlusion, and related retinal disease.

Ranke Complex

The late, healed, fibrocalcified sequela of primary pulmonary tuberculosis, consisting of a calcified subpleural Ghon parenchymal focus and calcified ipsilateral draining hilar or mediastinal lymph nodes visible on chest radiography.

Alternate Names:
Calcified Primary Tuberculous Complex; Healed Ghon Complex

Ranolazine

Ranolazine is an antianginal drug that inhibits the late sodium current in cardiac cells and reduces chronic angina without substantially lowering heart rate or blood pressure; QT prolongation and drug interactions require caution.

Ranson Criteria

An older scoring system that estimates the severity and risk of death in acute pancreatitis using clinical and blood-test findings at admission and again after 48 hours. It is less commonly used now because newer scores and organ-failure assessment may be more practical.

RANTES

RANTES, now called CCL5, is a chemokine that attracts immune cells and participates in inflammation, antiviral defense, and immune signaling.

Ranula

A soft, sometimes blue, mucus-filled swelling on the floor of the mouth under the tongue. It forms when mucus leaks from a saliva-making gland under the tongue, often after its tube is injured or blocked.

Raoultella

Raoultella is a genus of gram-negative bacteria that can cause opportunistic urinary, respiratory, wound, or bloodstream infections.

Rape

A form of sexual violence involving nonconsensual penetration, including penetration of the vulva, anus, or mouth with a body part or object. Legal definitions vary by jurisdiction. It can cause physical injury, pregnancy, sexually transmitted infection, and psychological trauma.

Raphe

A seam-like line or ridge where structures join, such as the median raphe or raphe nuclei of the brainstem.

Raphe Nuclei

The raphe nuclei are brainstem groups of neurons that produce serotonin and influence mood, pain, sleep, arousal, and autonomic functions.

Rapid Eye Movement Sleep

A sleep stage with rapid eye movements, vivid dreaming, and active brain patterns. Most skeletal muscles are temporarily relaxed during it, while breathing and heart rate can become more variable.

Alternate Names:
REM Sleep; Paradoxical Sleep

Rapid Eye Movement Sleep Behavior Disorder

Alternate name; see *REM Sleep Behavior Disorder*.

Rapid Gastric Emptying

Faster-than-normal movement of stomach contents into the small intestine. It can occur after stomach surgery and may cause dumping symptoms, but rapid emptying and dumping syndrome are not identical terms.

Rapid Heartbeat

Alternate name; see *Tachycardia*.

Rapidly Progressive Glomerulonephritis

Severe inflammation of the kidney's filtering units that causes kidney function to worsen over days or weeks. It may cause blood or protein in urine, swelling, high blood pressure, or reduced urine.

Rapid Plasma Reagin Test

A blood test that detects antibodies associated with syphilis. It is useful for screening and monitoring treatment, but false-positive and false-negative results occur, so reactive results need a confirmatory treponemal test.

Rapid Sequence Induction

See *Rapid Sequence Intubation*.

Rapid Sequence Intubation

An airway technique in which a sedative and a fast-acting muscle-relaxing medicine are given in quick succession before placing a breathing tube. It is used when rapid airway control is needed and aims to reduce the risk of stomach contents entering the lungs; ventilation between medicines may be used when clinically needed.

Rapid-Sequence Intubation

See *Rapid Sequence Intubation*.

Rapid Antigen Test

A rapid diagnostic immunoassay that directly identifies viral or bacterial antigens in clinical specimens within minutes; see *Antigen Detection Test*.

Rapid Shallow Breathing

Breathing that is faster than normal but moves only small amounts of air each time. It may occur with lung disease, pain, anxiety, metabolic illness, or tiring breathing muscles and can be a warning sign of respiratory failure.

Rapid Strep Test

A test performed on a throat swab to detect Group A Streptococcus. It provides a rapid result, but a negative result may require confirmatory testing depending on the patient's age, symptoms, and local guidance.

Rapp-Hodgkin Syndrome

A form of ectodermal dysplasia, usually caused by a change in the *TP63* gene. It can affect hair, teeth, nails, skin, and sweating and may occur with cleft lip or palate.

Alternate Names:
Rapp-Hodgkin Type Ectodermal Dysplasia

Rare Disease

A condition affecting relatively few people in a defined population; many rare diseases are genetic, require specialized diagnosis, and may have limited evidence or treatment options.

Rarefaction

A reduction in density or pressure, such as the low-pressure part of a sound wave. In medicine, understanding rarefaction helps explain ultrasound imaging, sound transmission, and pressure changes in tissues.

Rasburicase

A recombinant urate-oxidase enzyme that converts uric acid to the more soluble allantoin. It is used in selected patients at risk of or experiencing tumor-lysis-related hyperuricemia. It can cause serious hypersensitivity or hemolysis in people with glucose-6-phosphate dehydrogenase deficiency and requires appropriate screening and monitoring.

Rash

A visible change in skin color, texture, or surface, such as spots, bumps, blisters, or scaling. Causes include infection, allergy, medicines, and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Skin Eruption

Rasmussen Encephalitis

A rare, progressive, chronic immune-mediated neuroinflammatory disorder occurring predominantly in children, characterized by unilateral hemispheric inflammation, drug-resistant focal motor seizures (frequently epilepsia partialis continua), progressive contralateral hemiparesis, cognitive deterioration, and progressive unilateral cortical atrophy on neuroimaging.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Focal Encephalitis; Rasmussen Syndrome

Rasp

A roughened surgical instrument used to file, shape, or smooth bone or other hard tissue.

Ras Protein

A small GTP-binding protein that relays signals controlling cell growth, division, and survival. Abnormal Ras activity can contribute to cancer.

RAST

An older blood test that used a radioactive label to detect IgE antibodies to a specific allergen. Modern laboratories use newer specific-IgE tests; a positive result shows sensitization, which does not always mean clinical allergy.

Alternate Names:
Radioallergosorbent Test

Rastelli Procedure

Open-heart surgery for certain complex birth defects involving the heart's major arteries, a hole between the lower chambers, and a narrowed route to the lungs. A patch directs blood from the left ventricle to the aorta, and a tube with a valve connects the right ventricle to the lung arteries. The tube may need later replacement.

Alternate Names:
Rastelli Operation; Rastelli Repair

Rat Bite Fever

A systemic bacterial infection caused by Streptobacillus moniliformis or Spirillum minus, transmitted through rat bites or contact with rat-contaminated food or water. It presents with relapsing fever, rash, polyarthritis, and lymphadenopathy. The characteristic rash is petechial or maculopapular on the extremities.

Rat-Bite Fever

Alternate name; see *Rat Bite Fever*.

Rathke Cleft Cyst

A benign, non-neoplastic, mucin-filled sellar or suprasellar epithelial cyst derived from remnants of the embryonic Rathke pouch, which may compress the optic chiasm (causing bitemporal hemianopia) or normal pituitary gland (producing hypopituitarism).

Alternate Names:
RCC; Pituitary Cleft Cyst

Rathke Pouch

An embryonic ectodermal diverticulum arising from the roof of the stomodeum (primitive oral cavity) that ascends toward the developing brain to form the anterior pituitary gland (adenohypophysis: pars distalis, pars intermedia, pars tuberalis); incomplete obliteration gives rise to craniopharyngiomas or Rathke cleft cysts.

Ratio

A ratio compares two quantities by division, such as a measurement of risk, concentration, or body proportions.

Rationalization

A psychological defense in which a person creates plausible explanations for behavior or feelings while avoiding the underlying motive or conflict.

Rat Lungworm Disease

Infection caused by the rat lungworm parasite Angiostrongylus cantonensis, usually after eating contaminated raw or undercooked produce or animals. It can cause eosinophilic meningitis with headache, neck stiffness, or neurologic symptoms.

RATS

Alternate name; see *Robotic-Assisted Thoracoscopic Surgery*.

Ravuconazole

Ravuconazole is a triazole antifungal medicine studied and used in some settings for invasive fungal infections.

Raw Egg

An egg that has not been cooked; it may carry bacteria such as Salmonella.

Raynaud Disease

Primary Raynaud phenomenon, in which repeated episodes of reduced blood flow to the fingers or toes occur without an identified underlying condition.

Raynaud Phenomenon

Repeated episodes of reduced blood flow to the fingers or toes, usually triggered by cold or stress. Affected areas may turn white or blue and then red as blood flow returns, with numbness, tingling, or pain. It is primary when no underlying cause is found and secondary when associated with another condition, such as systemic sclerosis.

Alternate Names:
Raynaud's Phenomenon; Digital Vasospasm

Raynaud's Disease

Alternate name for *Raynaud Disease*.

Raynaud's Phenomenon

Alternate name; see *Raynaud Phenomenon*.

Raynaud's Syndrome

Alternate name for secondary Raynaud phenomenon.

Raynaud Syndrome

Raynaud phenomenon associated with an underlying condition, such as systemic sclerosis or lupus; also called secondary Raynaud phenomenon.

Razor Bumps

Inflamed bumps caused by hairs curling back into the skin after shaving or other hair removal. They are more common with coarse or curly hair and may cause itching, pain, dark marks, or scarring.

RBC Count

A measurement of the number of red blood cells in a volume of blood, interpreted with hemoglobin, hematocrit, and red-cell indices to evaluate anemia or erythrocytosis.

RBC Indices

Measurements describing the size, hemoglobin content, and variation of red blood cells. They help classify anemia and interpret a complete blood count alongside hemoglobin and other results.

RBC Nuclear Scan

An imaging test using the person's red blood cells labeled with a radioactive tracer. It can help locate active bleeding in the digestive tract or assess how well the heart's ventricles pump blood.

RBC Urine Test

A urine examination detecting or counting red blood cells, used to evaluate hematuria from urinary-tract infection, stones, glomerular disease, tumors, trauma, or other causes.

RDA

Recommended dietary allowance, the daily nutrient intake sufficient for nearly all healthy people in a defined group.

Alternate Names:
Recommended Dietary Allowance; Recommended Daily Allowance

Reabsorption

The transport of a substance from a body cavity or tubular fluid back into tissue or the bloodstream, such as renal tubular recovery of water and filtered solutes.

Reaction

A response of the body or mind to a stimulus, illness, medicine, treatment, or event. Examples include an allergic reaction, an immune reaction, a treatment response, and a psychological reaction; the cause and severity determine its importance.

Reactivation Tuberculosis

Active tuberculosis developing when a previously contained infection becomes active again, often years later. It commonly affects the upper lungs and may cause a long-lasting cough, coughing blood, fever, night sweats, weight loss, and spread to others through the air.

Reactive Arthritis

Painful inflammation of joints that develops during or after certain intestinal or genital infections. It may also cause eye inflammation, skin changes, or urinary symptoms, and the triggering infection may already have cleared.

Alternate Names:
Reiter Syndrome; Post-Infectious Arthritis

Reactive Attachment Disorder

A childhood trauma- and stressor-related disorder marked by emotionally withdrawn behavior toward adult caregivers: the child rarely seeks or responds to comfort when distressed. It follows a history of extremely insufficient care, such as severe social neglect, repeated changes in caregivers, or institutional rearing. Indiscriminate friendliness toward unfamiliar adults is characteristic of a separate condition, disinhibited social engagement disorder.

Reactive Gastropathy Pathology

Gastric mucosal injury characterized by foveolar hyperplasia, edema, smooth-muscle fibers in the lamina propria, vascular congestion, and relatively little active inflammation. Chemical injury, bile reflux, and medicines are common associations.

Reactive Hypoglycemia

A fall in blood sugar occurring within a few hours after eating. It may cause shakiness, sweating, hunger, weakness, dizziness, or confusion; diagnosis depends on low glucose being documented during symptoms.

Reactive Oxygen Species

Unstable oxygen-containing molecules produced during normal cell activity, infection, or inflammation. Small amounts can help cells signal and defend against germs, but excess amounts can damage cell membranes, proteins, and DNA.

Reactive Perforating Collagenosis

A skin condition in which damaged collagen from deeper skin is pushed through the surface. It causes small, firm, very itchy bumps with a central plug, often on the arms, legs, or hands, and may be associated with diabetes or kidney disease.

Reality Testing

The ability to recognize whether perceptions, thoughts, and beliefs match shared reality. Clinicians assess it during a mental-status examination; impaired reality testing can occur with psychosis, severe mood episodes, delirium, or some brain disorders.

Rebound Effect

Worsening or return of symptoms after stopping or reducing a treatment that had been suppressing them.

Rebound Headache

Alternate name; see *Medication Overuse Headaches*.

Rebound Insomnia

Return or worsening of insomnia after stopping a sleep medicine.

Rebound Tenderness

Pain that worsens when pressure on the abdomen is suddenly released. It can occur when the lining of the abdomen is irritated, but it does not identify the cause by itself.

Recalcitrant

Resistant to treatment, control, healing, or change; the term often describes a persistent disease or infection.

Receiver Operating Characteristic

A graph showing how a diagnostic test's ability to detect disease changes as its cutoff is changed. It compares true-positive and false-positive results; the area under the curve summarizes overall discrimination, not clinical usefulness by itself.

Recent Memory

Recent memory is the ability to recall information or events from the near past and can be impaired by aging, delirium, brain disease, depression, or medicines.

Receptor

A specialized transmembrane or intracellular macromolecular protein that selectively binds specific extracellular signaling ligands (such as neurotransmitters, hormones, cytokines, autocoids, or exogenous drugs) with high affinity, initiating conformational changes that transduce biochemical signals across the plasma membrane into intracellular effector pathways (e.g., G-protein coupled cascades, ligand-gated ion fluxes, receptor tyrosine kinase phosphorylation, or nuclear gene transcription).

Alternate Names:
Receptors

Receptor Binding

The attachment of a signaling molecule, medicine, or other ligand to a receptor on or inside a cell. Binding can activate, block, or change the receptor and its downstream cellular response.

Receptor Desensitization

A reduced cell response after a receptor is stimulated continuously or repeatedly. The change can develop quickly and helps prevent excessive signaling, but it may also reduce the effect of a medicine or natural body signal.

Receptor Downregulation

A decrease in the number or sensitivity of cell receptors after a signal stimulates them for a long time. The cell may remove receptors from its surface or break them down, becoming less responsive to the signal or medicine.

Receptors

Plural form; see *Receptor*.

Receptor Tyrosine Kinases

Cell-surface proteins that receive signals from hormones and growth factors. When switched on, they activate internal pathways controlling growth, survival, movement, and repair; abnormal activity can contribute to cancer and other disease.

Receptor Upregulation

An increase in the number or sensitivity of cell receptors after prolonged blocking of a signal or reduced stimulation. This adjustment can make a cell respond more strongly when the signal or medicine is later present.

Recession Of Medial Rectus Muscle

An eye operation that moves the medial rectus muscle backward to weaken its pull and correct certain inward eye deviations.

Recessive

Describing a gene change whose effect usually appears only when a person has two altered copies, one inherited from each parent. A person with one copy may carry it without having the condition.

RECIST

Standard rules for judging how a solid tumor changes on scans during treatment. Using measured lesions, they classify disease as completely gone, partly reduced, stable, or worsened; the categories support research and clinical decisions but do not replace overall assessment.

Recognizing Medical Emergencies

Identifying signs of a time-sensitive, potentially life-threatening condition, such as severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, stroke signs, major bleeding, seizure, collapse, poisoning, or altered consciousness.

Recognizing Teen Depression

Recognizing depression in adolescents involves looking for persistent low mood or irritability, loss of interest, sleep or appetite changes, poor concentration, hopelessness, or self-harm thoughts.

Recombinant

Produced by combining genetic material from different sources or by using engineered DNA in a cell or organism.

Recombinant DNA

DNA made by joining genetic material from different sources. It is used in biotechnology to produce medicines such as insulin and growth hormone, develop some vaccines, and create vehicles for gene therapy.

Recombinant Protein

A protein produced by putting its gene into a laboratory cell and growing the cell so it makes the protein. This method supplies some hormones, vaccines, antibodies, enzymes, and research materials.

Recombinant Tissue Plasminogen Activator

A laboratory-made form of tissue plasminogen activator that helps convert plasminogen to plasmin and dissolve blood clots. It is used in selected emergencies, such as some ischemic strokes, heart attacks, or pulmonary emboli, when benefits outweigh bleeding risk.

Alternate Names:
rtPA; Alteplase; Recombinant tPA

Recombinase

An enzyme that cuts, joins, or rearranges DNA segments. It helps cells exchange genetic material, repair some DNA damage, and assemble the gene parts needed to make a varied immune response.

Recombinational Repair

A way cells repair a serious DNA break by using a matching, undamaged DNA copy as a guide. It restores genetic information accurately; inherited problems with this repair can increase cancer risk and treatment sensitivity.

Recommended Daily Allowance

The Recommended Dietary Allowance is the average daily nutrient intake sufficient for nearly all healthy people in a specified age and sex group.

Recommended Dietary Allowance

The average daily intake expected to meet the nutrient needs of nearly all healthy people in a defined group.

Alternate Names:
RDA

Record

A health record is a documented account of a person's history, findings, tests, diagnoses, treatments, decisions, and outcomes.

Recovery Position

A side-lying position used for an unconscious but normally breathing person to help keep the airway open and reduce aspiration risk.

Recreation Therapy

Recreation therapy uses adapted games, arts, exercise, and leisure activities to support physical, emotional, cognitive, or social functioning.

Recrudescence

Recurrence of symptoms or infection after apparent improvement, often from persistence of the original organism or disease process.

Rectal

Rectal means relating to the rectum, the final section of the large intestine before the anal canal.

Rectal Biopsy

Removal of a small piece of tissue from the rectum for examination under a microscope. It can help investigate missing nerve cells, inflammation, infection, abnormal growth, or other rectal disease.

Rectal Bleeding

Blood coming from the anus or mixed with stool. It may come from hemorrhoids, small tears, bowel inflammation, growths, or cancer. Heavy, ongoing, or unexplained bleeding needs medical assessment.

Alternate Names:
Hematochezia

Rectal Cancer

Cancer developing in the rectum, the final part of the large intestine. Symptoms may include bleeding, altered bowel habits, pain, or weight loss; treatment may combine surgery, radiation, chemotherapy, immunotherapy, or targeted therapy.

Rectal Carcinoma

Rectal carcinoma is cancer arising in the rectum and may cause bleeding, altered bowel habits, pain, or anemia.

Alternate Names:
Rectal Cancer

Rectal Culture

Laboratory culture of a rectal specimen to detect selected bacterial pathogens or colonization, depending on the clinical indication.

Rectal Disease

A disorder affecting the rectum, including inflammation, infection, bleeding, obstruction, prolapse, functional disease, or neoplasm.

Rectal Fistula

A rectal fistula is an abnormal tract connecting the rectum with skin or another organ, often causing

drainage, infection, or passage of stool through an abnormal route.

Rectal Hemorrhage

Bleeding from the rectum, which may result from hemorrhoids, fissure, inflammation, ischemia, polyps, cancer, trauma, or other gastrointestinal disease.

Rectal Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Proctitis*.

Rectal Itching

Alternate name; see *Anal Itching*.

Rectal Mucositis

Rectal mucositis is inflammation and injury of the rectal lining, often after radiation, chemotherapy, infection, inflammatory disease, or trauma.

Rectal Necrosis

Rectal necrosis is death of rectal tissue from inadequate blood flow, severe inflammation, infection, pressure, or another destructive process.

Rectal Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the rectum that may be noncancerous, precancerous, or cancerous. It can cause bleeding, altered bowel habits, pain, anemia, or no symptoms and may require examination and biopsy.

Rectal Obstruction

Impaired passage through the rectum caused by fecal impaction, stricture, tumor, foreign body, inflammation, or functional outlet disorder.

Rectal Perforation

A tear or hole through the rectal wall that can release bowel contents and cause peritonitis, sepsis, or severe bleeding.

Rectal Polyposis

Rectal polyposis is the presence of multiple polyps in the rectum, which may be sporadic or part of an inherited syndrome and can increase cancer risk.

Rectal Polyps

Alternate name; see *Colon Polyps*.

Rectal Prolapse

The rectum slipping downward and partly or completely coming through the anus. It may cause a visible bulge, bleeding, mucus, discomfort, or difficulty controlling or passing stool and can result from weakened pelvic support, straining, or nerve problems.

Rectal Prolapse Repair

A surgical or procedural treatment that restores a prolapsed rectum to its normal position and secures or removes affected tissue according to the prolapse and patient factors.

Rectal Route

The rectal route administers a medicine or fluid through the anus into the rectum, where it may act locally or be absorbed systemically.

Rectal Stenosis

Abnormal narrowing of the rectal lumen caused by inflammation, scarring, surgery, radiation, ischemia, trauma, or neoplasm.

Rectal Tenesmus

Rectal tenesmus is a persistent or urgent feeling of needing to pass stool despite an empty or nearly empty rectum, caused by inflammation, infection, mass, or motility disorder.

Rectal Ulcer

An open sore in the lining of the rectum. Causes include solitary rectal ulcer syndrome, inflammatory bowel disease, infection, reduced blood flow, radiation, or injury; evaluation depends on symptoms and examination findings.

Rectocele

Bulging of the rectum into the back wall of the vagina because supporting tissues have weakened.

It may cause pelvic pressure, difficulty emptying the bowel, or a vaginal bulge.

Rectosigmoid Junction

The point where the sigmoid colon joins the rectum.

Rectosigmoid Neoplasm

A rectosigmoid neoplasm is an abnormal growth where the sigmoid colon joins the rectum and may be benign or malignant.

Rectouterine Pouch

The rectouterine pouch, or pouch of Douglas, is the peritoneal recess between the uterus and rectum where fluid or disease may collect.

Rectovaginal Fistula

Abnormal connection between the rectum and vagina causing passage of stool or gas through the vagina. Causes include obstetric injury particularly third and fourth degree perineal tears, Crohn disease, radiation therapy, and surgical complications. Presents with vaginal discharge of stool, flatus, or recurrent vaginal infections.

Rectum

The final straight section of the large intestine, approximately 12-15 cm long, extending from the sigmoid colon to the anal canal. The rectum stores feces before defecation.

Rectus Abdominis

The rectus abdominis is a paired abdominal muscle that flexes the trunk, stabilizes the pelvis, and helps compress abdominal contents.

Rectus Abdominis Muscle

The paired vertical muscles at the front of the abdomen, commonly called the “six-pack.” They bend the trunk forward, stabilize the pelvis, and help increase pressure inside the abdomen; stretching can cause separation during pregnancy or after major weight change.

Rectus Abdominis Sheath

A fibrous aponeurotic envelope formed by the abdominal wall muscles and surrounding the rectus abdominis muscle. It contains the superior and inferior epigastric vessels and related nerves.

Rectus Sheath Hematoma

A collection of blood within the sheath surrounding the rectus abdominis muscle, often caused by muscle strain, coughing, trauma, anticoagulation, or vessel injury. It may cause localized abdominal pain and a tender mass.

Recur

To recur means to return or happen again, as symptoms, disease, infection, or a tumor after a period of improvement or treatment.

Recurrence

The return of a disease after it improved or seemed to disappear. Cancer may return at the original site, nearby lymph nodes, or another part of the body; recurrence does not always mean that treatment is no longer possible.

Recurrence-Free Survival

The length of time after treatment during which a disease does not return. In cancer studies, it usually ends when cancer is found again or when a person dies, depending on the study rules. It measures control of disease, not a guarantee that treatment has cured it.

Recurrence Risk

The chance that a disease or condition will return after treatment or occur again in a future pregnancy or family member. The estimate depends on the condition, previous history, test results, inheritance pattern, and other risk factors.

Recurrent

Happening again after a period of improvement, remission, or apparent absence. A recurrent condition may return at the original site or elsewhere; examples include repeated urinary infections, repeated seizures, or cancer returning after treatment.

Recurrent Breast Cancer

Breast cancer that returns after a period when tests found no detectable disease. It may recur near the original site or elsewhere and is assessed with examination, imaging, biopsy, and other tests.

Recurrent Caries

Tooth decay that develops beneath or beside an existing filling, crown, or other restoration. It may result from leaking edges, plaque, frequent sugar, or dry mouth and can cause sensitivity, pain, or further tooth damage.

Recurrent Disease

Return of a disease after a period of improvement, remission, or apparent absence, either at the original site or elsewhere.

Recurrent Early Pregnancy Loss

Repeated miscarriages occurring early in pregnancy. Evaluation may consider uterine anatomy, chromosomal factors, antiphospholipid syndrome, endocrine or metabolic disease, parental genetics, and other causes, although no cause is found in many cases.

Recurrent Fractures

Repeated bone fractures, suggesting persistent trauma, osteoporosis, bone fragility, metabolic disease, tumor, or an inherited skeletal disorder.

Recurrent Laryngeal Nerve

A branch of the vagus nerve supplying most intrinsic muscles of the larynx; injury can cause hoarseness.

Recurrent Laryngeal Nerve Palsy

Weakness or paralysis of the vocal fold muscles supplied by the recurrent laryngeal nerve, usually from surgery, tumor compression, or other nerve injury. It can cause hoarseness; bilateral injury may obstruct breathing, and swallowing problems may increase aspiration risk.

Alternate Names:
RLN Palsy

Recurrent Oral Ulcers

Alternate name; see *Canker Sore*.

Recurrent or Metastatic Breast Cancer

Breast cancer that returns after treatment or has spread from the breast to distant organs or tissues. Assessment and treatment depend on the site of disease, hormone-receptor and HER2 status, prior therapy, symptoms, and the person's goals.

Recurrent Pregnancy Loss

Two or more miscarriages. Possible causes include chromosome changes, an unusual shape of the uterus, hormone or thyroid problems, antiphospholipid syndrome, or other medical conditions, although no cause is found in many people. Evaluation is individualized and may identify treatment that improves the chance of a future healthy pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Recurrent Miscarriage; Recurrent Miscarriages; Habitual Abortion; RPL

Recurrent Prostate Cancer

Alternate name; see *Prostate Cancer*.

Recurrent Respiratory Papillomatosis

A disease in which wart-like growths caused by human papillomavirus develop in the larynx or other breathing passages. The growths can cause hoarseness, noisy breathing, airway narrowing, or repeated recurrence.

Recurrent Urinary Tract Infection

Repeated urinary tract infections separated by periods without infection. They may affect the bladder or kidneys and can be related to bacteria that persist, incomplete bladder emptying, stones, urinary blockage, or other urinary-tract problems.

Red Birthmarks

Red birthmarks are vascular skin marks present at or soon after birth, ranging from harmless capillary marks to lesions requiring monitoring or specialist treatment.

Red Blood Cell

A blood cell that carries oxygen from the lungs to the body's tissues. It contains hemoglobin, has a flattened, indented shape, and lacks a nucleus, which helps it bend through small blood vessels. Red blood cells also carry some carbon dioxide back to the lungs and help keep the blood's acid level balanced. They are made mainly in the bone marrow and normally live for about 120 days.

Red Blood Cell Count

A laboratory measurement of the number of circulating erythrocytes per volume of blood; see *Red Blood Cell* and *Complete Blood Count*.

Red Blood Cell Casts

Tube-shaped groups of red blood cells seen in urine. They form inside the kidney's small tubes and strongly suggest bleeding or inflammation in the kidney's filtering units, such as glomerulonephritis or vasculitis.

Alternate Names:
RBC Casts

Red Blood Cell Labeling

A nuclear-medicine technique in which a person's red blood cells are marked with a small amount of radioactive material. Scans can then show active digestive-tract bleeding or assess how well the heart's ventricles pump blood.

Red Bone Marrow

Bone marrow that makes red blood cells, white blood cells, and platelets. It is found mainly in certain bones and in the spongy parts of many bones.

Red Cell Distribution Width

A complete blood count measurement of variation in red blood cell size, also called anisocytosis. An increased value may occur in several types of anemia and is interpreted with the other blood-count results; it cannot by itself distinguish iron deficiency from thalassemia trait.

Alternate Names:
RDW

Red Cell Indices

Standardized automated complete blood count parameters derived from hemoglobin, hematocrit, and erythrocyte count that quantify red blood cell physical properties: mean corpuscular volume (MCV), mean corpuscular hemoglobin (MCH), and mean corpuscular hemoglobin concentration (MCHC).

Red Eye

Redness of the white part of the eye caused by irritation, dryness, allergy, infection, injury, inflammation, or increased surface blood flow.

Red Flag

A symptom, sign, or test result associated with a potentially serious condition. Its significance depends on the clinical context.

Red Hepatization

A stage of acute lobar pneumonia in which the affected lung becomes firm and red as air spaces fill with red blood cells, immune cells, and fibrin. The appearance resembles liver tissue.

Alternate Names:
Second Stage of Lobar Pneumonia; Consolidation Stage

Red Infarction

Tissue death caused by loss of blood flow in which blood also leaks into the damaged area, making it dark red. It is more likely in organs with a second blood supply or when a vein is blocked.

Alternate Names:
Hemorrhagic Infarction

Red Man Syndrome

An older term for vancomycin infusion reaction, a rate-related reaction that can cause flushing, itching, and redness of the face, neck, and upper body during or after an infusion.

Alternate Names:
Vancomycin Infusion Reaction Vancomycin Flushing Reaction Vancomycin Flushing Syndrome Histaminoid Infusion Reaction

Red-Man Syndrome

See *Red Man Syndrome*.

Red Nucleus

A group of nerve cells in the midbrain that helps coordinate movement through connections with the cerebellum and spinal cord. Damage to nearby pathways can cause weakness, tremor, or abnormal movement.

Reductase Deficiency

A disorder or laboratory finding caused by inadequate activity of a reductase enzyme, impairing a specific metabolic or hormone pathway.

Reduction

Restoration of a displaced fracture or joint to better alignment, or decrease in amount, size, or activity.

Reduction Division

The first division of meiosis, when a reproductive cell's chromosome number is reduced by half. It produces cells with one chromosome from each pair and helps create genetic variation in eggs and sperm.

Reduction Mammaplasty

Surgery that removes breast tissue, fat, and excess skin to reduce breast size and relieve symptoms such as neck, shoulder, or back discomfort; it may also reshape the breasts.

Redundant Mitral Valve

Excess leaflet tissue of the mitral valve, most commonly the posterior leaflet, which may prolapse into the left atrium during systole. Often associated with myxomatous degeneration and mitral valve prolapse. May be asymptomatic or cause mild mitral regurgitation detected incidentally on echocardiography.

Red Urine

Urine that looks pink or red. It may contain blood, but foods, medicines, or other substances can also change its color. A urine test can help find the cause.

Reduviidae

A family of insects including assassin bugs; some species transmit pathogens such as the parasite causing Chagas disease.

Reed-Sternberg Cells

Large abnormal immune cells derived from B lymphocytes and commonly found in classic Hodgkin lymphoma. Their appearance in a tissue sample helps pathologists confirm that diagnosis.

Reexpansion Pulmonary Edema

A sudden buildup of fluid in a lung after it rapidly expands from a collapsed state, often after drainage of a large or long-standing pneumothorax. It can cause severe breathlessness, low oxygen, and respiratory failure.

Refeeding Syndrome

Dangerous changes in body salts and fluid balance when food is restarted after severe or prolonged undernutrition. Low phosphate, potassium, or magnesium can cause weakness, swelling, abnormal heart rhythms, breathing failure, or death.

Reference Interval

The range of results usually found in a selected healthy reference group, often covering the middle 95 percent. A result outside it does not by itself prove disease and must be interpreted with symptoms, history, and the laboratory's own method.

Referral

A request for assessment or treatment by another healthcare professional or service. Referrals help patients access specialized expertise, tests, procedures, rehabilitation, or coordinated care for a particular concern.

Referred Otalgia

Ear pain arising from a problem elsewhere, such as a tooth, jaw joint, throat, or neck, while the ear itself may appear normal. It occurs because these areas share sensory nerve pathways with the ear.

Referred Pain

Pain felt in an area away from the tissue causing it because nearby or connected nerves share pathways to the brain. Examples include shoulder pain from irritation below the diaphragm or arm and jaw pain during a heart attack.

Reflex

An involuntary, stereotyped, and rapid neuromuscular or autonomic functional response to a specific sensory stimulus, mediated across an intact neural circuit known as a reflex arc (comprising a sensory receptor, afferent limb, central integrating synapse, efferent limb, and effector organ). Clinical evaluation of deep tendon reflexes (muscle stretch reflexes), superficial reflexes (e.g., plantar response), and cranial nerve reflexes (corneal, pupillary light reflex) provides localizing diagnostic information regarding the integrity of peripheral nerves, spinal cord roots, and central upper motor neuron pathways.

Alternate Names:
Reflexes

Reflex Action

A rapid, automatic response to a stimulus that occurs through a nerve pathway called a reflex arc. Reflexes protect the body, maintain posture, and provide information about nerve and spinal-cord function.

Reflex Anoxic Seizure

A brief fainting episode that can look like a seizure after sudden pain, fright, or emotional stress. The heart slows briefly, the person becomes pale and unresponsive, and jerking may occur before rapid recovery.

Reflex Arc

The nerve pathway that produces a rapid, automatic response. It includes a sensor, a sensory nerve, a processing center in the spinal cord or brain, a motor nerve, and the muscle or gland that responds.

Reflex Epilepsy

Reflex epilepsy is epilepsy in which specific stimuli such as flashing light, sound, reading, or touch reliably trigger seizures.

Reflexes

Plural form; see *Reflex*.

Reflux

The backward flow of a body fluid, especially stomach contents into the esophagus or urine from the bladder toward the kidneys. Symptoms and risks depend on the type, frequency, and underlying cause.

Reflux Esophagitis Pathology

Mucosal injury associated with gastroesophageal reflux, often showing basal-zone hyperplasia, elongation of lamina-propria papillae, intercellular edema, and variable eosinophils or neutrophils.

Reflux Laryngitis

Irritation or inflammation of the larynx attributed to reflux of stomach contents into the throat or upper airway. Hoarseness, throat clearing, cough, globus sensation, or throat discomfort may occur, though these symptoms also have other causes.

Reflux Nephropathy

Renal scarring and chronic kidney damage caused by vesicoureteral reflux, recurrent urinary infection, or both. It may lead to hypertension, proteinuria, impaired growth, and chronic kidney disease.

Refraction

The bending of light as it passes through the cornea, aqueous humour, lens, and vitreous humour. In an eye examination, refraction determines the optical power needed to focus a clear image on the retina; refractive power is measured in dioptres.

Refractive Disorder

A vision problem caused by the eye not focusing light correctly on the retina. Nearsightedness, farsightedness, astigmatism, and presbyopia are common refractive disorders and may be corrected with glasses, lenses, or surgery.

Refractive Error

A refractive error occurs when the eye does not focus light correctly on the retina, causing nearsightedness, farsightedness, astigmatism, or presbyopia.

Refractive Errors And Astigmatism

Refractive errors are vision disorders caused by the eye's inability to properly focus light onto the retina, resulting in blurred vision.

Refractive Surgery

Surgery that changes the cornea or, in some procedures, the eye's lens to reduce refractive errors such as myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism. Procedures include laser reshaping of the cornea and implantation or exchange of lenses. Outcomes and risks, including dry eye, glare, or residual refractive error, vary by procedure and patient.

Alternate Names:
Corrective Eye Surgery

Refractometer

A refractometer measures how much light bends through a substance and is used for fluid concentration, optical properties, or eye refraction.

Refractometry

Measurement of the eye's refractive power to determine the optical correction needed for myopia, hyperopia, astigmatism, or presbyopia.

Refractory

Resistant to a treatment or not responding adequately to it. The term may refer to cancer or other diseases.

Refractory Anemia

An older name for some myelodysplastic syndrome subtypes involving persistent anemia. It is not a preferred general term for any anemia that fails to improve with treatment.

Refractory Cancer

Refractory cancer is cancer that does not respond adequately to a treatment or begins progressing during treatment.

Refractory Disease

Disease that does not improve adequately with appropriate standard treatment or that continues to worsen despite therapy. The term does not mean that every possible treatment has failed.

Refractory Period

The brief recovery time after a nerve or muscle cell sends an electrical signal. During this time it cannot, or can only partly, send another signal, which helps control the speed and direction of nerve and heart activity.

Refractory Phaeohyphomycosis

Phaeohyphomycosis that persists, progresses, or recurs despite antifungal treatment. The infection may be localized, deep, or disseminated; "refractory" describes its clinical response and does not by itself establish antifungal resistance.

Refrigerant Poisoning

Poisoning from inhaling or contacting a refrigerant gas or liquid. Exposure can cause dizziness, abnormal heart rhythms, suffocation, frostbite, chemical burns, or lung injury.

Refsum Disease

A rare inherited disorder in which phytanic acid builds up in the body, usually because it cannot be broken down normally. It can cause night blindness, loss of smell, nerve damage, poor coordination, hearing loss, and scaly skin.

Regadenoson Pharmacological Stress

A stress test using regadenoson, a medicine that temporarily widens the heart arteries to assess blood flow during cardiac imaging when a person cannot exercise adequately.

Regeneration

Growth or replacement of damaged or lost cells and tissues, helping restore structure or function after injury.

Regimen

A planned schedule for medicines, treatments, diet, exercise, or other healthcare steps. It states what to do, how much or how often, and for how long, and may be changed according to response or side effects.

Regional

Relating to a particular body area, geographic area, or localized distribution rather than the whole body.

Regional Anatomy

The study of all structures within a particular body region and the relationships among them, such as the anatomy of the head and neck, thorax, abdomen, or limb.

Regional Anesthesia

Numbing a larger body area by injecting local anesthetic near the nerves supplying it. The person is usually awake, although sedation may be added; the block can provide numbness during surgery and pain relief afterward.

Alternate Names:
Conduction Anesthesia

Regional Chemotherapy

Treatment that delivers anticancer medicine directly to a body region or organ to produce a high local concentration while reducing, but not eliminating, exposure elsewhere. It is suitable only for selected cancers and carries procedure-related and medicine-related risks.

Regional Enteritis

An older name for Crohn disease, a chronic inflammatory bowel disease that can affect any part of the digestive tract.

Regional Ileitis

An older name for Crohn disease affecting the ileum, especially its terminal part.

Regulation Of Health Professions

Legal and professional systems that govern healthcare workers' education, licensing, permitted duties, conduct, and accountability. Regulation aims to protect patients, maintain competence, support ethical care, and address unsafe practice.

Regulatory Approval

Authorization by a competent regulatory authority for a medicine, device, or procedure to be marketed or used for specified purposes after review of evidence.

Regulatory Authority

A regulatory authority is a government or official body that sets and enforces standards for medicines, devices, facilities, professionals, or public health.

Regulatory Gene

A gene that controls when, where, or how strongly another gene is used. Changes in regulatory genes or their control regions can alter development, cell growth, metabolism, or disease risk.

Regulatory T Cells

Immune cells that limit excessive immune reactions and help prevent attacks against the body's own tissues. They develop mainly in the thymus or from other T cells in tissues. Problems with their function can contribute to autoimmune disease.

Regurgitation

Backward flow of a body fluid, especially blood through a heart valve that does not close fully or stomach contents into the esophagus. The medical meaning depends on the organ involved.

Rehab

Alternate name; see *Rehabilitation*.

Rehabilitation

A coordinated process that helps a person restore or adapt physical, cognitive, psychological, and social function after illness, injury, surgery, or disability.

Rehabilitation Clinic

An outpatient facility where a team helps people re-

gain or adapt movement, communication, thinking, daily activities, or independence after illness, injury, surgery, or disability. Services may include physical, occupational, speech, or other rehabilitation therapies.

Rehabilitation Engineering

The use of engineering and technology to improve independence after illness or disability. It includes artificial limbs, braces, wheelchairs, communication aids, home adaptations, and devices that help control the environment.

Rehabilitation Motivation

A person's willingness and ability to take part in rehabilitation and work toward functional goals. Pain, mood, fatigue, cognition, support, confidence, and the expected benefit can all influence participation.

Rehabilitation Potential

The expected capacity to improve function, independence, participation, or quality of life through rehabilitation. It depends on diagnosis, prognosis, cognition, motivation, comorbidity, social support, and environmental resources.

Rehabilitation Unit

A hospital unit for people who need coordinated medical care and intensive therapy after a serious illness or injury, such as stroke, brain or spinal-cord injury, or major surgery. The team works to restore safe movement, daily skills, communication, and independence.

Rehydration

Replacement of water and electrolytes lost through dehydration, commonly using oral fluids or intravenous treatment when necessary.

Reid Index

A microscope measurement comparing the thickness of mucus-making glands with the wall of a large airway. A higher value may be seen in chronic bronchitis, but it is not used alone to diagnose the condition.

Alternate Names:
Bronchial Gland-to-Wall Ratio; Reid Histopathologic Index

Reifenstein Syndrome

An inherited disorder of androgen action, usually involving partial androgen insensitivity in an individual with a 46,XY chromosome pattern.

Reiki

A complementary practice involving light touch or holding the hands near the body. It is sometimes used for relaxation, but it has not been shown to treat disease.

Reinfection

A new episode of infection by the same or a related pathogen after the original infection has resolved. Reinfection is distinct from relapse, in which the original infection persists or returns from an incompletely eradicated focus.

Reinke Edema

Chronic polypoid degeneration and diffuse, gelatinous mucoid edema within the superficial lamina propria (Reinke's space) of both true vocal cords, strongly associated with chronic cigarette smoking and vocal strain, presenting with progressive hoarseness and a deepened voice.

Alternate Names:
Polypoid Corditis; Diffuse Vocal Fold Edema

Reinnervation

Restoration of nerve supply to a muscle or tissue after nerve repair, regeneration, or collateral nerve growth.

Rejection

An immune response in which the body recognizes transplanted tissue or an organ as foreign and attacks it. Rejection can damage or destroy the transplant, may be sudden or gradual, and is monitored and treated with immune-suppressing medicines.

Alternate Names:
Allograft Rejection; Graft Rejection

Relapse

Return or reappearance of a disease, or its signs and symptoms, after a period of improvement or remission. In substance-use disorders, relapse means renewed use after a period of abstinence.

Relapse-Free Survival

The time from a defined point in a cancer study to relapse or another specified event, often including death. The study protocol defines when the period starts and which events count.

Relapsing Fever

An acute febrile illness caused by Borrelia species, characterized by recurrent episodes of fever separated by afebrile intervals.

Relapsing Polychondritis

A rare immune disease in which episodes of inflammation damage cartilage. It commonly affects the ears, nose, eyes, joints, or windpipe and may cause pain, swelling, hearing or breathing problems; airway involvement can be life-threatening.

Relapsing-Remitting Multiple Sclerosis

A form of multiple sclerosis in which neurological symptoms appear in attacks and then improve partly or completely for periods of time. Symptoms may include vision changes, numbness, weakness, balance problems, or fatigue. Treatment can reduce relapses and new nerve damage, although the course varies between people.

Alternate Names:
RRMS; Relapsing-Remitting MS

Relative Afferent Pupillary Defect

Unequal response of the pupils because one eye or optic nerve sends less light information to the brain than the other. During a swinging-light test, both pupils may appear to dilate when the light moves to the affected eye; it can indicate retinal or optic-nerve disease.

Alternate Names:
RAPD; Marcus Gunn Pupil

Relative Biological Effectiveness

A comparison of how strongly two types of radiation produce the same biological effect at the same absorbed dose. It depends on the radiation type, dose, tissue, and biological outcome.

Relative Bradycardia

A heart rate that is lower than expected for the degree of fever. It can occur in several infections and other conditions, but is not specific to a particular diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Sphygmothermic Dissociation; Inappropriate Bradycardia in Fever

Relative Risk

A comparison of the chance of an outcome in an exposed group with its chance in an unexposed group. A value above 1 suggests higher risk, a value below 1 suggests lower risk, and 1 suggests no difference.

Relaxation

A reduction in muscle tension, physiologic arousal, or psychological stress; techniques may include breathing, biofeedback, or progressive muscle relaxation.

Relaxation Response

The body's calming changes after activities such as slow breathing, meditation, or progressive muscle relaxation. Heart rate, breathing, muscle tension, and stress-related alertness may decrease.

Relaxation Techniques For Stress

Relaxation techniques for stress include slow breathing, progressive muscle relaxation, meditation, guided imagery, and other methods that reduce physical arousal.

Relaxation Therapy

Techniques such as breathing, muscle relaxation, or imagery used to reduce stress, arousal, or symptom burden.

Relaxin

Relaxin is a reproductive hormone that helps remodel connective tissue and may contribute to cervical, pelvic, and vascular changes during pregnancy.

Religion

A system of spiritual beliefs and practices that may influence health decisions, coping, diet, treatment preferences, and end-of-life care.

Relocation Test

A shoulder examination often performed after an apprehension test. The examiner gently supports the front of the shoulder while the arm is in a vulnerable position. Relief of fear or pain may support shoulder instability, but the result must be interpreted with the rest of the examination.

Alternate Names:
Fowler Test; Jobe Relocation Test

REM

Rapid eye movement, a sleep stage associated with vivid dreams and intense brain activity.

Alternate Names:
Rapid Eye Movement; REM Sleep

REM Behavior Disorder

A sleep disorder where a person physically acts out dreams because normal muscle relaxation during REM sleep is lost.

Alternate Names:
RBD; REM Sleep Behavior Disorder

Remedy

A treatment or measure intended to relieve a symptom or illness; safety and effectiveness depend on the specific remedy and condition.

Remifentanil

A very short-acting opioid pain medicine given by infusion during anesthesia or intensive procedures. Its effects wear off quickly after the infusion stops, but it can slow breathing, lower blood pressure, and cause opioid-related complications.

Remission

A period when the signs, symptoms, or measurable activity of a disease decrease or disappear. Partial remission indicates improvement with residual disease; complete remission means the disease is not detectable by currently available methods or criteria. Definitions vary by condition, and remission does not always mean cure or permanent resolution.

Remittent Fever

Fever that rises and falls during the day but remains above normal temperature, rather than returning completely to normal.

Remodeling

The body's ongoing process of removing old tissue and building new tissue to adapt to use, injury, growth, or disease. Bone remodeling responds to stress, hormones, nutrition, and medicines throughout life.

Remote Surgery

Surgery performed when the surgeon is physically separated from the patient and controls robotic instruments through a telecommunications system. It may also include remote surgical assistance or guidance, with a qualified local team available to manage the patient and respond to emergencies.

Alternate Names:
Telesurgery Telepresence Surgery

Removal Technique

The method used to take away a foreign object, diseased tissue, stone, clot, or other material from the body. The appropriate method depends on its location, size, cause, and risk of bleeding, infection, or injury to nearby structures.

REM Rebound

An increase in rapid-eye-movement sleep after sleep loss, REM deprivation, or stopping a medicine that suppresses REM sleep. It may cause vivid dreams, nightmares, or temporary changes in sleep patterns.

REM Sleep

A sleep stage with rapid eye movements, active brain activity, and temporary relaxation of most skeletal muscles. Vivid dreams are common, and REM sleep supports memory, learning, emotional processing, and healthy development.

REM Sleep Behavior Disorder

A sleep disorder in which the normal muscle paralysis of REM sleep is reduced or absent, allowing a person to move or vocalize while dreaming.

Alternate Names:
Rapid Eye Movement Sleep Behavior Disorder

Renal

Renal means relating to the kidneys, which filter blood, regulate fluid and electrolytes, produce hormones, and excrete urine.

Renal Abscess

A localized collection of pus within or around the kidney, usually caused by infection. Diagnosis and treatment may require imaging, antibiotics, and drainage.

Renal Adenoma

A renal adenoma is a usually benign kidney tumor, often discovered incidentally; its size, imaging features, and growth determine whether follow-up is needed.

Renal Agenesis

A condition present at birth in which one or both kidneys fail to form. One absent kidney may cause no symptoms if the other works well, but absence of both kidneys is usually fatal before or shortly after birth.

Renal and Ureteral Injury

Injury to a kidney or ureter from blunt trauma, a penetrating wound, or a medical procedure. It may cause blood in the urine, flank pain, bleeding around the kidney, or urine leakage; severity and treatment depend on the injury.

Renal And Urological Diseases

Renal and urological diseases affect the kidneys, urinary tract, bladder, urethra, or male reproductive urinary organs.

Renal Anemia

Anemia associated with chronic kidney disease. Diseased kidneys make less erythropoietin, a hormone that stimulates red-cell production, and iron deficiency or inflammation may add to the problem, causing tiredness and breathlessness.

Renal Angioplasty

A minimally invasive vascular procedure using a balloon catheter to widen narrowed renal arteries, often accompanied by stent placement; see *Angioplasty*.

Renal Arteriography

Renal arteriography uses contrast X-rays to visualize kidney arteries and may identify narrowing, bleeding, aneurysm, or vascular anatomy during an intervention.

Renal Artery

One of the two main arteries carrying blood from the abdominal aorta to the kidneys. Each divides into smaller branches inside the kidney so blood reaches the filtering tissue.

Renal Artery Aneurysm

A focal enlargement of a renal artery, often asymptomatic but capable of causing hypertension, thromboembolism, or rupture. Management depends on size, symptoms, anatomy, pregnancy, and growth, and may involve surveillance, endovascular treatment, or surgery.

Renal Artery Disease

Disease affecting one or more arteries supplying the kidneys, including narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or dissection.

Renal Artery Doppler

Doppler ultrasound that measures blood flow in the renal arteries. It may help assess narrowing or

blockage that can contribute to renovascular hypertension.

Renal Artery Embolism

Sudden blockage of an artery supplying the kidney, often by a clot from the heart in atrial fibrillation or another heart condition. It may cause abrupt side pain, blood in urine, nausea, or kidney injury.

Renal Artery Stenosis

Narrowing of an artery supplying a kidney. It can reduce kidney blood flow and contribute to high blood pressure or worsening kidney function. Causes include atherosclerosis and fibromuscular dysplasia.

Alternate Names:
RAS; Renal Artery Narrowing

Renal Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Kidney Biopsy*. It is used selectively for unexplained acute kidney injury, nephrotic syndrome, glomerular hematuria, or transplant dysfunction; bleeding is the main complication.

Renal Calculi

Alternate medical term; see *Kidney Stone*.

Renal Calculus

A kidney stone, a hard mass of mineral crystals formed in the urinary tract. It may pass without symptoms or cause severe wave-like pain, blood in the urine, blockage, vomiting, or urinary infection.

Renal Cancer

Alternate name; see *Kidney Cancer*.

Renal Carcinoma

Cancer arising from kidney tissue, most often renal cell carcinoma, which begins in cells lining the kidney's small filtering units.

Renal Cell Carcinoma

The most common type of kidney cancer in adults, originating in the tiny tubes within the kidney that filter blood and produce urine. As the tumor grows, it can cause blood in the urine (hematuria), a dull ache or lump in the side or lower back (flank pain), fever, unexplained weight loss, and fatigue. In some cases, the tumor produces excess hormones that trigger high blood pressure, high red blood cell counts, or elevated blood calcium levels.

Alternate Names:
RCC; Hypernephroma; Grawitz Tumor; Renal Cell Adenocarcinoma

Renal Cell Carcinoma Pathology

Pathologic classification of renal cell carcinoma by growth pattern, cytology, immunophenotype, necrosis, sarcomatoid or rhabdoid change, and invasion. Clear cell, papillary, chromophobe, and other recognized subtypes have different features and behavior.

Renal Changes In Pregnancy

Pregnancy increases renal blood flow and glomerular filtration. These changes lower usual serum creatinine values and may increase urinary loss of glucose and amino acids.

Renal Circulation

Blood flow through the kidneys, which supports filtration, oxygen delivery, hormone production, and regulation of fluid and electrolytes.

Renal Clearance

A measure of how quickly the kidneys remove a substance from the blood. It is usually calculated from blood and urine levels and helps assess kidney function or adjust some medicine doses.

Renal Colic

Severe, intermittent flank pain, most often caused by acute obstruction of the ureter by a stone. It may radiate toward the groin and occur with nausea, vomiting, or blood in the urine. The term is also called ureteric colic; other ureteral obstructions can cause a similar pattern.

Renal Corpuscle

The first part of a kidney filtering unit, made of a tiny ball of blood vessels inside a cup-shaped capsule. Water and small dissolved substances pass out of the blood here to begin urine formation.

Renal Cortex

The outer layer of the kidney. It contains many of the structures that filter blood and process the first fluid that will become urine, while extensions of the cortex separate the inner kidney pyramids.

Renal Cryptococcosis

Infection of the kidney by Cryptococcus species, usually as part of disseminated cryptococcosis in an immunocompromised person.

Renal Cyst

Alternate name; see *Kidney Cysts*.

Renal Dialysis

Alternate term for dialysis: kidney replacement therapy using hemodialysis or peritoneal dialysis to remove excess fluid and dissolved waste products when kidney function is inadequate.

Renal Diet

An eating plan adjusted for kidney disease. Depending on kidney function and treatment, it may limit sodium, potassium, phosphorus, or fluid while providing enough calories and protein; needs differ between people and during dialysis.

Renal Disease

Any acute or chronic pathological condition impairing the structure or physiological function of the kidneys, encompassing glomerular, tubulointerstitial, vascular, obstructive, and cystic disorders. Major manifestations include acute kidney injury (AKI), chronic kidney disease (CKD), nephrotic and nephritic syndromes, and end-stage renal disease (ESRD), leading to disruptions in fluid homeostasis, electrolyte and acid-base regulation, blood pressure control, and nitrogenous metabolic waste excretion.

Alternate Names:
Renal Diseases; Kidney Disease; Nephropathy

Renal Diseases

Plural form; see *Renal Disease*.

Renal Dose Adjustment

Modification of a medication dose, dosing interval, or both to account for reduced kidney clearance. It depends on kidney-function estimates, drug pharmacokinetics, treatment indication, and, for some medicines, therapeutic drug monitoring.

Renal Dysplasia

Abnormal development of kidney tissue before birth. It may affect one or both kidneys and can cause reduced kidney function, high blood pressure, urine reflux, or other urinary-tract problems.

Renal Dysplasia And Cystic Disease

A group of developmental or inherited kidney disorders in which the kidneys have abnormal tissue, cysts, or both. They may affect one or both kidneys and can reduce kidney function or cause high blood pressure.

Renal Failure

See *Kidney Failure*.

Renal Function

The kidneys' ability to filter blood, remove waste, regulate fluids and electrolytes, maintain acid-base balance, and produce or activate hormones.

Renal Glomerulus

A tiny ball of blood vessels inside each kidney filtering unit. Water and small dissolved substances pass from the blood through its walls to begin urine formation, while blood cells and most proteins remain in the bloodstream.

Renal Hamartoma

An imprecise, older term for a benign-appearing disorganized growth in the kidney. It has sometimes been used for renal angiomyolipoma, now classified as a neoplasm rather than a hamartoma.

Renal Hypertension

High blood pressure caused by kidney disease or reduced blood flow to the kidneys, often from narrowing of a renal artery.

Renal Hypertrophy

Renal hypertrophy is enlargement of kidney tissue, often compensating for loss or reduced function of the other kidney but sometimes caused by disease.

Renal Hypoperfusion

Reduced blood flow to the kidneys, which can lower filtration and cause acute kidney injury. Causes include dehydration, blood loss, shock, heart failure, renal artery disease, and severe hypotension.

Renal Infarction

Death of part of the kidney caused by a blocked blood vessel. It may cause sudden flank or abdominal pain, nausea, blood in the urine, or reduced kidney function.

Renal Insufficiency

Renal insufficiency is reduced kidney function that impairs waste removal, fluid and electrolyte balance, acid handling, or hormone production.

Renal Leukemia Infiltration

Spread of leukemia cells into kidney tissue. It may enlarge both kidneys and reduce kidney function, sometimes causing sudden kidney injury, blood or protein in urine, or high blood pressure; treatment focuses on the underlying leukemia.

Renal Lithiasis

Alternate name; see *Kidney Stones*.

Renal Manifestations of Sickle Cell Disease

Kidney complications of sickling disorders, including excessive urination, impaired concentration, hematuria, proteinuria, papillary necrosis, acute kidney injury, and progressive chronic kidney disease. Blood pressure and urine abnormalities require ongoing monitoring.

Renal Mass

An abnormal area seen in or on a kidney during imaging. It may be a harmless cyst, infection, scar, benign growth, or cancer; its appearance, size, growth, and sometimes biopsy determine the next step.

Renal Medulla

The inner part of the kidney containing tubes and blood vessels that help concentrate urine. It receives the fluid processed by the outer kidney and directs the finished urine toward the kidney's central collecting area.

Renal Necrosis

Renal necrosis is death of kidney tissue caused by severe ischemia, toxins, infection, obstruction, or other injury and can cause acute kidney failure.

Renal Oncocytoma

A renal oncocytoma is a usually benign kidney tumor arising from oncocytic cells; imaging may not always distinguish it reliably from renal cancer.

Renal Osteodystrophy

The bone changes that are part of chronic kidney disease mineral and bone disorder. Changes in calcium, phosphate, vitamin D, parathyroid hormone, and bone remodeling can affect bone strength and growth; the pattern and treatment vary with the person and kidney disease.

Renal Papillary Necrosis

Renal papillary necrosis is death of the kidney papillae from ischemia, infection, obstruction, diabetes, sickle-cell disease, or analgesic injury and may cause blood or obstruction.

Renal Parenchyma

The working tissue of the kidney, containing the tiny filtering units and supporting structures that remove waste from blood, balance body fluids, and produce urine.

Renal Pelvis

The funnel-shaped expansion of the ureter within the kidney, formed by the union of major calyces. It collects urine from the renal papillae and directs it into the ureter.

Renal Pelvis Or Ureter Cancer

Cancer of the renal pelvis or ureter usually arises from urothelial cells lining the urinary tract and may cause blood in the urine.

Renal Perfusion Scintiscan

A nuclear medicine study using a radiotracer to evaluate renal blood flow and relative perfusion of the kidneys.

Renal Pyramids

Cone-shaped structures in the renal medulla that contain tubules and collecting ducts and drain urine toward the renal papillae.

Renal Reabsorption

The return of water and useful substances, such as salt, sugar, and bicarbonate, from kidney tubes into the blood. This prevents their unnecessary loss and helps control body fluids and chemistry.

Renal Replacement Therapy

Alternate name; see *Kidney Replacement Therapy*.

Renal Replacement Therapy Indications

Clinical problems that may require urgent dialysis include severe electrolyte or acid-base disturbances, certain poisonings, fluid overload causing organ dysfunction, or complications of waste buildup. Decisions also consider kidney recovery, overall health, and the person's goals.

Renal Salt-Wasting Syndrome

Excessive loss of sodium and other salts through the kidneys, causing low blood sodium, dehydration, low blood pressure, or muscle symptoms. Causes include inherited tubular disorders, medicines, kidney disease, and hormonal problems.

Renal Sarcoma

Renal sarcoma is a rare malignant tumor arising from connective or supporting tissues of the kidney.

Renal Scan

A nuclear medicine test using a small radioactive tracer to assess kidney blood flow, drainage, or separate function. The tracer and scan method are chosen according to the clinical question.

Renal Scintigraphy

Nuclear imaging that follows a radioactive tracer through the kidneys. It can compare kidney function, assess blood flow and urine drainage, detect obstruction, or monitor a transplanted kidney.

Renal Stone

A renal stone is a solid crystal aggregate formed in the kidney that can pass through the urinary tract or obstruct urine flow.

Renal Transitional Cell Carcinoma

Older name; see *Upper Tract Urothelial Carcinoma*.

Renal Transplantation

Surgical placement of a functioning donor kidney into a person with advanced kidney failure. It can restore kidney function but requires suitability assessment and long-term immunosuppression.

Alternate Names:
Kidney Transplant; Kidney Transplantation

Renal Trauma

Kidney injury caused by a blow, fall, crash, sports injury, or penetrating wound. Assessment may include urine testing and CT imaging; treatment ranges from observation to procedures or surgery depending on severity.

Renal Tubular Acidosis

A group of disorders in which kidney tubules do not remove enough acid or return enough bicarbonate to the blood. This makes the blood too acidic and may cause weakness, kidney stones, bone disease, or high potassium.

Renal Tubular Acidosis Type 1

A metabolic acidosis caused by an impaired ability of distal intercalated renal tubular cells to secrete hydrogen ions into the collecting duct lumen. Characterized by normal anion gap metabolic acidosis, inap-

propriately high urinary pH (greater than 5.5 in the setting of systemic acidemia), hypokalemia, hypocitraturia, and recurrent nephrolithiasis or nephrocalcinosis.

Alternate Names:
Distal RTA; Type 1 RTA

Renal Tubular Acidosis Type 2

A normal anion gap hyperchloremic metabolic acidosis caused by defective proximal tubular reabsorption of filtered bicarbonate, resulting in bicarbonate wasting into the urine. Urinary pH is typically elevated initially but drops below 5.5 when systemic acidosis becomes severe; frequently associated with generalized proximal tubular dysfunction (Fanconi syndrome) including glucosuria, aminoaciduria, phosphaturia, and osteomalacia.

Alternate Names:
Proximal RTA; Type 2 RTA

Renal Tubular Acidosis Type 4

A kidney-tubule disorder that causes a mild buildup of acid in the blood and often a high potassium level. It is commonly associated with reduced aldosterone activity, diabetes, or some medicines.

Alternate Names:
Hyperkalemic RTA

Renal Tubular Disorders

Diseases affecting the kidney tubules, which reabsorb water and useful substances and remove selected wastes into urine. They can disturb acid-base balance, electrolytes, urine concentration, or blood pressure.

Renal Tubule

A tiny nephron tube that reabsorbs needed water and substances and removes others into urine.

Renal Tubule Acidosis

Alternate name; see *Renal Tubular Acidosis*.

Renal Ultrasound

Noninvasive imaging used to assess kidney size, structure, blood flow, and urinary obstruction. It is particularly useful when obstruction, cystic disease, or structural abnormality is suspected and is often used in the evaluation of acute or chronic kidney disease.

Renal Vascular Disease

Alternate name; see *Renovascular Disease*.

Renal Vein

One of two large veins that carry blood away from the kidneys to the body's main abdominal vein. A clot in a renal vein can impair drainage and damage kidney function.

Renal Vein Thrombosis

Renal vein thrombosis is a clot in a kidney vein that can cause flank pain, blood or protein in urine, kidney dysfunction, swelling, or pulmonary embolism.

Renal Venogram

Contrast imaging of the renal veins used selectively to evaluate venous anatomy, thrombosis, obstruction, or vascular abnormalities.

Renaut Body

A Renaut body is a specialized cluster of cells in the peripheral nerve endoneurium, associated with pressure sensitivity and sometimes nerve pathology.

Renin

An enzyme from kidney cells that starts a hormone chain controlling blood pressure, salt balance, and fluid levels.

Renin-Angiotensin-Aldosterone System

A hormone system that raises blood pressure and preserves body fluid when circulation or kidney blood flow falls. It narrows blood vessels and signals the adrenal glands to retain salt and water; overactivity contributes to hypertension and heart failure.

Renin-Angiotensin-Aldosterone System Physiology

See *Renin-Angiotensin-Aldosterone System*.

Renin-Angiotensin System

A hormone and enzyme system that regulates blood pressure, fluid balance, and vascular tone. Renin initiates formation of angiotensin II, which promotes vasoconstriction and aldosterone release; excessive activation contributes to hypertension and heart failure.

Renin Blood Test

A blood test measuring renin concentration or activity, interpreted with aldosterone, posture, sodium status, medications, and blood pressure to evaluate hypertension or mineralocorticoid disorders.

Rennin

An enzyme, also called chymosin, that helps curdle milk in the stomachs of young mammals. It is distinct from renin, the kidney enzyme that helps regulate blood pressure.

Renography

A kidney scan that follows a small amount of radioactive tracer as it enters and leaves the kidneys. It can compare kidney function and help identify reduced blood flow or blocked urine drainage.

Renovascular Disease

Disease of the blood vessels supplying or draining the kidneys. It includes narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, or other vessel abnormalities and may reduce kidney blood flow or contribute to high blood pressure.

Renovascular Hypertension

High blood pressure caused by reduced blood flow through one or both kidney arteries, usually from narrowing. It may be suspected when hypertension begins suddenly or is difficult to control; treatment addresses blood pressure and, in selected cases, the narrowed artery.

Renshaw Cell

A nerve cell in the spinal cord that helps limit and regulate the activity of motor neurons.

Reoviridae Infection

An infection caused by a reovirus; illness varies by virus and host and is often mild or asymptomatic in humans.

Rep

An abbreviation most often meaning one repetition of an exercise or movement. In medical records it can also mean representative or another phrase, depending on context.

Repair Of Webbed Fingers Or Toes

Surgery to separate joined fingers or toes and reconstruct the skin between them. It may improve movement, growth, function, or appearance; wound problems, scarring, and recurrence of joining are possible.

Repeat Surgery

Repeat surgery is a second or subsequent operation on the same or related area to treat persistent disease, recurrence, complications, or failure of prior treatment.

Reperfusion

Restoration of blood flow to tissue after ischemia or a marked reduction in perfusion. It returns oxygen and nutrients and may preserve cells that remain viable, occurring spontaneously or after treatment of an obstructed vessel. The return of flow can also trigger inflammatory, oxidative, and microvascular changes that contribute to reperfusion injury.

Reperfusion Injury

Damage that occurs when blood flow returns to tissue after a period of inadequate flow. The returning oxygen and inflammation can worsen injury, causing swelling, bleeding, or loss of function in organs such as the heart, brain, kidneys, or limbs.

Reperfusion Therapy

Treatment that restores blood flow to tissue deprived of oxygen, such as clot-dissolving medicine, angioplasty, stenting, or surgery. Benefit depends on the tissue, duration of blockage, and risk of bleeding.

Repetitive Motion Disorders

Conditions caused or worsened by repeated movement, force, vibration, or awkward posture. They may affect muscles, tendons, nerves, or joints and can cause pain, numbness, weakness, or reduced function.

Repetitive Nerve Stimulation

A test that gives a nerve several small electrical impulses while recording the muscle's response. A changing response may support a disorder in communication between nerves and muscles, such as myasthenia gravis or Lambert-Eaton syndrome. The result is interpreted with the examination and other tests.

Alternate Names:
RNS; Repetitive Stimulation Test

Repetitive Strain Injury

Pain or dysfunction caused by repeated forceful movements, sustained positions, or overuse of muscles, tendons, nerves, or other tissues.

Replantation Of An Avulsed Tooth

Reinsertion of a completely displaced permanent tooth into its socket after injury. The tooth may be stabilized with a splint; root-canal treatment and follow-up may be needed, depending on the tooth and injury.

Replantation Of Digits

Microsurgical replacement of a completely amputated finger or toe, reconnecting bone, tendons, nerves, arteries, and veins when feasible.

Replication Initiation

The time and process when copying of DNA or another genetic molecule begins. Specific proteins recognize a starting region, separate the strands, and recruit enzymes that build matching new genetic material.

Replicon

A unit of genetic material that can replicate from one origin, such as a chromosome segment, plasmid, or viral genome.

Repolarization

The return of the membrane potential toward the resting value after depolarization. In neurons and skeletal/cardiac muscle, repolarization is primarily caused by the efflux of potassium through voltage-gated potassium channels and inactivation of sodium channels.

Reportable Diseases

Reportable diseases are illnesses that must be notified to public-health authorities under applicable laws to support surveillance and outbreak control.

Reporting Standards

Agreed rules for recording and communicating clinical or imaging findings. Structured reports improve completeness and consistency and can make important results, follow-up needs, and comparisons easier for clinicians to understand.

Repressed Memory Therapy

A controversial approach aimed at recovering allegedly repressed memories; suggestive techniques can create false memories and require caution.

Repression

The reduction or stopping of gene activity, cell activity, behavior, or a body process. In genetics, regulatory proteins can silence genes; in psychology, the term may describe unconsciously keeping distressing thoughts outside awareness.

Reproduction

The biological process by which living organisms produce new offspring, either sexually or without combining reproductive cells. In humans, it involves reproductive organs, hormones, eggs, sperm, pregnancy, and childbirth.

Reproductive Cells

Cells used for reproduction, mainly sperm in males and eggs in females. Each normally carries half the usual number of chromosomes.

Reproductive History

Reproductive history records pregnancies, births, miscarriages, abortions, menstrual function, fertility, contraception, and related conditions relevant to health assessment.

Reproductive Hormones

Hormones that regulate sexual development, reproductive organs, ovulation, menstruation, sperm production, pregnancy, and lactation. Examples include estrogen, progesterone, testosterone, luteinizing hormone, and follicle-stimulating hormone.

Reproductive Medicine

The medical field concerned with reproductive health, fertility, and disorders of the reproductive system. It includes reproductive endocrinology, infertility evaluation, assisted conception, fertility preservation, and related hormonal or anatomic conditions; its scope varies across health systems.

Reproductive Organs

Organs involved in reproduction, including the ovaries, uterus, uterine tubes, vagina, testes, ducts, prostate, and penis. The structures present and their functions vary among individuals.

Reproductive System

The organs and tissues that produce gametes and reproductive hormones and support sexual development and reproduction. Depending on the anatomy present, it may enable sperm or egg production, fertilization, pregnancy, childbirth, and lactation.

Reproductive Technique

A reproductive technique is a medical or laboratory method used to assist conception, preserve fertility, diagnose reproductive disease, or manage pregnancy.

Reproductive Toxicity

Harmful effects of a substance on fertility, pregnancy, the developing baby, birth outcomes, or later growth. Risks depend on the substance, dose, timing, route, and individual health.

Reproductive Years

The part of life when a person may be able to become pregnant or produce sperm. Fertility varies widely and is affected by age, health, reproductive organs, hormones, and medicines; age alone does not determine fertility.

Reprogram

To reprogram a cell means to alter its gene-expression state so it acquires a different developmental potential or function.

Resectable

Describing a tumor or lesion that can be removed completely by surgery with acceptable risk and an appropriate margin, based on its extent and relationship to vital structures.

Resection

Surgical removal of tissue, an abnormal growth, or part or all of an organ. The purpose and extent depend on the condition and procedure; removed tissue may be examined to clarify a diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Excision; Surgical Removal

Resectoscope

An endoscopic surgical instrument with a viewing system and working loop used to remove or cauterize tissue, especially during prostate or bladder procedures.

Reserve Volume

The additional amount of air that can be inhaled or exhaled beyond a normal tidal breath.

Reservoir

A human, animal, or environmental habitat in which an infectious agent normally lives, multiplies, and persists. A reservoir may serve as the source from which the agent is transmitted to a susceptible host.

Reservoir Of Infection

A reservoir of infection is a person, animal, environment, or material in which an infectious organism

normally lives and from which transmission can occur.

Resident

A resident is a physician or other trainee receiving supervised specialty education after initial professional qualification; the term can also mean a person living in a place.

Residential Mobility

Residential mobility is movement between homes or communities and can affect continuity of care, social support, exposure, and health access.

Residual

Residual means remaining after a process, treatment, measurement, or event, such as residual urine, disease, risk, or volume.

Residual Limb

The portion of a limb remaining after amputation. Care includes edema control, skin inspection, shaping, strengthening, desensitization, contracture prevention, and prosthetic preparation.

Residual Limb Pain

Pain in the remaining portion of a limb after amputation.

Alternate Names:
Stump Pain

Residual Neoplasm

A residual neoplasm is tumor tissue that remains after treatment intended to remove or destroy the original tumor.

Residual Risk

Residual risk is the chance of harm that remains after preventive measures, treatment, screening, or controls have been applied.

Residual Tumor

A residual tumor is cancer or other tumor tissue that remains after surgery, radiation, chemotherapy, or another treatment.

Residual Volume

The amount of air remaining in the lungs after breathing out as forcefully as possible. It keeps small airways open and cannot be measured accurately by ordinary spirometry alone.

Resistance

The ability of a microorganism to survive a medicine that previously inhibited or killed it. Resistance can make infections harder to treat and may spread between organisms through genetic material.

Alternate Names:
Antimicrobial Resistance; Drug Resistance

Resistance Training

Exercise in which muscles work against weights, bands, body weight, or other resistance. Regular training can improve strength, endurance, balance, bone health, function, and independence when progressed safely.

Resistant Hypertension

Blood pressure above goal despite three or more antihypertensive drug classes, including a diuretic, at maximum or maximally tolerated doses; the term also includes blood pressure controlled with four or more medicines. Diagnosis requires consideration of adherence and exclusion of a white-coat effect.

Alternate Names:
Treatment-Resistant Hypertension

Resistant Starch

Starch that resists digestion in the small intestine and is fermented by gut bacteria in the colon.

Resistin

A signaling protein associated with adipose tissue and inflammation; its human clinical significance remains under study.

Resolution

The ability of an imaging system to distinguish separate structures, or the improvement or disappearance of a disease or symptom.

Resonance

Amplification or characteristic vibration produced when a system is driven at a suitable frequency; used in sound and MRI contexts.

Resorcinol

A phenolic compound used in selected topical dermatologic preparations; concentrated exposure can irritate or poison.

Resorption

The body's breakdown and removal of tissue or material, especially old bone. The released components may be absorbed, reused, or removed from the body.

Resorption Atelectasis

Collapse of lung tissue distal to a completely obstructed airway as trapped gas is absorbed into pulmonary blood. Common causes include a mucus plug, foreign body, or tumor; imaging typically shows increased opacity with volume loss.

Respiration

The processes of breathing, gas exchange, and cellular energy production involving oxygen and carbon dioxide.

Respiratory

Respiratory means relating to breathing, the airways, lungs, gas exchange, or the organs and muscles that move air.

Respiratory Acidosis

A condition in which breathing does not remove enough carbon dioxide, making the blood too acidic. It can result from lung disease, blocked airways, weak breathing muscles, brain disorders, or medicines that slow breathing.

Respiratory Alkalosis

A condition in which breathing removes too much carbon dioxide, making the blood less acidic. It can occur with anxiety, pain, fever, low oxygen, pregnancy, severe infection, or other conditions that cause rapid breathing.

Respiratory Arrest

Cessation of effective spontaneous breathing, resulting in inadequate ventilation and oxygenation. It may occur while circulation is still present or as part of cardiorespiratory arrest. Causes include respiratory, neurologic, neuromuscular, toxic, and obstructive disorders; prolonged respiratory arrest can cause hypoxic injury.

Respiratory Burst

A rapid release of chemically reactive oxygen molecules by certain immune cells after they engulf germs. This helps kill the germs inside the cell, although excessive activity can also damage nearby tissue.

Respiratory Changes In Pregnancy

Pregnancy changes breathing as the growing uterus raises the diaphragm and hormones increase the drive to breathe. Breaths may become deeper, overall ventilation increases, and the amount of air left after a normal breath out decreases.

Respiratory Compliance

The physical measure of the distensibility and elastic stretchability of the lungs and chest wall, expressed mathematically as the change in lung volume per unit change in distending pressure ($\Delta V/\Delta P$); reduced in acute respiratory distress syndrome, pulmonary edema, and pulmonary fibrosis.

Alternate Names:
Lung Compliance

Respiratory Depression

Breathing that is abnormally slow or shallow, causing inadequate ventilation and possible carbon-dioxide retention or low oxygen. Medicines, brain disorders, and metabolic illness can cause it.

Respiratory Disease

Any disease affecting the airways, lungs, breathing muscles, or gas exchange. Examples include asthma, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, pneumonia, tuberculosis, and lung cancer.

Respiratory Disorder

A disease affecting the airways, lungs, pleura, respiratory muscles, or control of breathing and causing impaired ventilation, oxygenation, or gas exchange.

Respiratory Distress

Difficult or labored breathing caused by problems such as asthma, infection, a blood clot, a collapsed lung, an allergic reaction, or heart failure. Fast breathing, struggling to speak, blue lips, or severe exhaustion may occur.

Respiratory Distress Syndrome

An ambiguous term that may refer to neonatal respiratory distress syndrome, usually caused by insufficient surfactant in a newborn's lungs, or acute respiratory distress syndrome (ARDS), an acute lung injury that causes low blood oxygen. These are distinct conditions, so the intended disorder should be specified.

Respiratory Drive

The brain's signal to the breathing muscles that controls how often and how deeply a person breathes. It responds mainly to carbon-dioxide and oxygen levels and can be reduced by brain disease, severe illness, or sedating medicines.

Respiratory Failure

A life-threatening inability of the lungs to provide enough oxygen or remove enough carbon dioxide. It may cause severe breathlessness, confusion, blue or gray lips, extreme sleepiness, or collapse. Causes include lung disease, infection, heart problems, weak breathing muscles, brain injury, and drug overdose.

Respiratory Failure Types 1 and 2

A classification based on blood gases. Type 1 is hypoxemic respiratory failure, with low arterial oxygen and usually normal or low carbon dioxide. Type 2 is hypercapnic respiratory failure, with elevated arterial carbon dioxide, often from inadequate ventilation. Exact thresholds vary by clinical context.

Respiratory Gating

A radiation-treatment method that tracks breathing and delivers the beam only during a selected part of the breathing cycle. It helps account for movement of tumors in the chest or upper abdomen and may reduce radiation to nearby healthy tissue.

Respiratory Health

The ability of the lungs, airways, and breathing muscles to move air and exchange oxygen and carbon dioxide effectively.

Respiratory Illness

A short-term or long-term illness affecting breathing or the respiratory tract. Symptoms may include cough, fever, congestion, wheezing, shortness of breath, or chest discomfort, depending on the cause.

Respiratory Infection

An infectious process affecting any portion of the respiratory tract, conventionally classified into upper respiratory tract infections (URIs, e.g., rhinitis, pharyngitis, sinusitis, laryngitis) and lower respiratory tract infections (LRIs, e.g., acute bronchitis, bronchiolitis, pneumonia, lung abscess). Caused by an extensive spectrum of viral, bacterial, fungal, and atypical pathogens, severity ranges from mild, self-limited coryza to life-threatening respiratory distress and sepsis requiring mechanical ventilation.

Alternate Names:
Respiratory Infections; Respiratory Tract Infection; RTI

Respiratory Infections

Plural form; see *Respiratory Infection*.

Respiratory Insufficiency

Inadequate breathing or gas exchange that causes low oxygen, high carbon dioxide, or both. It can result from lung or airway disease, weak breathing muscles, or problems in the brain's breathing control and may progress to respiratory failure.

Respiratory Medicine

Alternate name; see *Pulmonology*.

Respiratory Muscle

A muscle used for breathing, especially the diaphragm and muscles between the ribs. These muscles expand and contract the chest to move air into and out of the lungs.

Respiratory Neoplasm

A respiratory neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the airways or lungs and may be benign or malignant.

Respiratory Paralysis

Respiratory paralysis is failure of the muscles needed for breathing because of nerve, muscle, brainstem, toxin, or spinal-cord dysfunction and is an emergency.

Respiratory Physiology

The study of how breathing works, including movement of air, exchange of oxygen and carbon dioxide in the lungs, transport of gases in blood, and control of breathing.

Respiratory Protection

Measures and equipment used to reduce inhalation of harmful dusts, fumes, gases, aerosols, or infectious particles.

Respiratory Quotient

The ratio of carbon dioxide produced to oxygen used by the body's cells. The value changes according to whether the body is mainly using carbohydrate, fat, or protein and helps estimate metabolism and energy needs.

Respiratory Rate

The number of breaths taken per minute. The expected rate varies with age, activity, temperature, illness, and other factors.

Respiratory Rehabilitation

A program of exercise, education, breathing techniques, and self-management that improves function and quality of life in people with chronic respiratory disease.

Respiratory Syncytial Virus

A respiratory virus that commonly causes bronchiolitis and pneumonia in infants and young children. Infection is usually mild in adults but may be severe in infants, older adults, and people with chronic heart or lung disease.

Respiratory Syncytial Virus Bronchiolitis

An acute lower respiratory tract infection occurring predominantly in infants under two years of age caused by respiratory syncytial virus (RSV), characterized by bronchiolar mucosal inflammation, edema, and epithelial sloughing leading to wheezing, tachypnea, cough, and intercostal retractions.

Respiratory Syncytial Virus Infection

A common contagious respiratory illness caused by respiratory syncytial virus (RSV) that usually causes cold-like symptoms. It can also cause bronchiolitis or pneumonia, especially in infants and young children. Severe illness is more likely in older adults and people with certain heart, lung, or immune-system conditions. People can get RSV more than once.

Alternate Names:
RSV; Human Orthopneumovirus

Respiratory Syncytial Virus (RSV)

Alternate name; see *Respiratory Syncytial Virus*.

Respiratory System

The nose, mouth, pharynx, larynx, trachea, bronchi, bronchioles, lungs, pleura, and breathing muscles, including the diaphragm and chest-wall muscles. It moves air into and out of the lungs and exchanges oxygen and carbon dioxide between the alveoli and blood.

Respiratory Therapy

Respiratory therapy includes treatments and breathing support that improve ventilation, oxygenation, airway clearance, or lung function.

Respiratory Tract Infections

Infections affecting any part of the respiratory tract,

classified by anatomical location into upper respiratory tract infections (URTIs) and lower respiratory tract infections (LRTIs).

Respiratory Transport

Respiratory transport is movement of oxygen and carbon dioxide between lungs, blood, and tissues, largely through hemoglobin and dissolved gas.

Respiratory Viruses

Viruses that cause respiratory tract infections. Major respiratory viruses include influenza, respiratory syncytial virus (RSV), parainfluenza virus, adenovirus, and human metapneumovirus. SARS-CoV-2 causes COVID-19. Symptoms range from mild upper respiratory illness to severe pneumonia.

Respiratory Viruses And Face Masks

Face masks can reduce spread of respiratory viruses by blocking droplets and some aerosols, especially in crowded or healthcare settings; fit and local guidance matter.

Respirologist

A doctor specializing in diseases of the lungs and breathing system. They assess breathing problems, interpret tests, manage chronic and acute illness, and may evaluate people for lung transplantation.

Respirovirus

A genus of paramyxoviruses that includes human parainfluenza viruses, which can cause croup and other respiratory infections.

Respite Care

Temporary care for a person who needs support so that a usual family or unpaid caregiver can rest, attend appointments, or manage other responsibilities. It may be provided at home, in a facility, or through short-term services.

Response Assessment

Evaluation of how a disease responds to treatment. Clinicians may use symptoms, examination, blood tests, scans, tumor measurements, or activity levels to decide whether treatment is helping, failing, or needs adjustment.

Response Evaluation Criteria

Standardized rules for judging whether a disease, especially a tumor, has responded to treatment, remained stable, or progressed. RECIST mainly uses tumor measurements on imaging; other systems may use metabolic or blood-based findings.

Responsible Drinking

Responsible drinking means limiting alcohol according to health guidance, avoiding driving or hazardous activities after drinking, and avoiding alcohol when it is unsafe or contraindicated.

Rest

Rest is reduced physical or mental activity used to recover, though excessive inactivity can impair strength and function in some conditions.

Restenosis

Re-narrowing of a blood vessel after it has been opened by angioplasty or another procedure.

Resting Energy Expenditure

The energy the body uses at rest for essential functions such as breathing, circulation, and cell activity. It varies with body size, age, body composition, illness, and other factors.

Alternate Names:
REE; Resting Metabolic Rate

Resting Membrane Potential

The small electrical difference across a nerve or muscle cell when it is not sending a signal. Unequal amounts of charged particles inside and outside the cell create it and allow the cell to respond quickly to stimulation.

Resting Phase

The resting phase is a period of relative inactivity, such as G0 in the cell cycle or a physiologic interval between active events.

Resting Tremor

An involuntary, rhythmic oscillation (typically four to six hertz) occurring in a body part that is fully supported against gravity and relaxed, which diminishes or temporarily ceases with voluntary movement. It typically presents as a pill-rolling hand tremor in Parkinson's disease and other parkinsonian syndromes.

Restless Anal Syndrome

A label used in a single published case report for restless discomfort around the anus that worsened at rest and improved with movement. It is not an established diagnostic syndrome; anorectal, neurologic, and other causes of anal discomfort are considered separately.

Restless Legs

Alternate name; see *Restless Legs Syndrome*.

Restless Legs Syndrome

A neurological and sleep-related condition causing an irresistible urge to move the legs, often with crawling, pulling, aching, or tingling sensations. Symptoms begin or worsen during rest, improve temporarily with movement, and are worse in the evening or at night; they may disrupt sleep and daytime function. Iron deficiency, kidney disease, pregnancy, some medicines, and genetic factors may contribute.

Alternate Names:
RLS; Willis-Ekbom Disease

Restless Legs Syndrome (RLS)

Alternate name; see *Restless Legs Syndrome*.

Restless Leg Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Restless Legs Syndrome*.

Restlessness

Restlessness is an uncomfortable need to move or inability to remain still, caused by anxiety, akathisia, restless-legs syndrome, pain, stimulants, withdrawal, or medical illness.

Restorative Dentistry

Specialty of restoring damaged teeth. Procedures: fillings, inlays, onlays, crowns, bridges, implants. Goals: function, aesthetics, durability.

Restraint

A device, medicine, or other measure used to limit a person's movement. Restraints can cause injury, distress, falls, and loss of independence.

Restraint-Related Harm

Physical or psychological injury associated with using a device, medication, or environmental restriction to limit a person's movement. Older adults are at risk of falls, pressure injury, delirium, aspiration, and functional decline.

Restriction Enzyme

An enzyme made by bacteria that cuts DNA at particular short sequences. Scientists use these enzymes to analyze, join, or modify DNA in laboratory research and medical testing.

Restrictive Cardiomyopathy

A disease in which stiff heart muscle cannot relax and fill normally. It may cause breathlessness, tiredness, swelling, or abnormal rhythms and can result from conditions such as amyloidosis, sarcoidosis, iron overload, or scarring.

Restrictive Lung Disease

A pattern of reduced total lung capacity caused by stiff lung tissue, chest-wall limitation, respiratory-muscle weakness, obesity, or other factors. It may cause exertional breathlessness and low oxygen; lung volumes, imaging, muscle strength, and the underlying cause guide management.

Resuscitation

Emergency measures used to restore or support breathing and circulation. Depending on the cause, these may include airway support, rescue breathing, chest compressions, defibrillation, and medicines.

Resuscitative Thoracotomy

Emergency chest surgery used for selected trauma patients who are in cardiac arrest or close to it, especially after a penetrating chest injury. It may relieve blood around the heart, control bleeding, or allow direct heart compressions. It is a last-resort procedure with a high risk of death and complications.

Alternate Names:
Emergency Department Thoracotomy; EDT; Clamshell Thoracotomy; Trauma Thoracotomy

Retained Placenta

Failure of the placenta to come out after childbirth, usually when it remains in the uterus for about 30 minutes or longer or bleeding is excessive. It can cause severe bleeding or infection.

Retained Products Of Conception

Pregnancy tissue that remains in the uterus after childbirth, miscarriage, or abortion. It may cause continuing or heavy bleeding, cramping, fever, or infection and may be treated with medicine or a procedure to remove it.

Retainer

A dental appliance worn after orthodontic treatment to help keep teeth in their corrected positions.

Retching

Repeated involuntary effort to vomit without necessarily producing stomach contents.

Retention Of Urine

Inability to empty the bladder completely or at all despite making urine. It may cause painful fullness, leaking, or kidney damage and can result from blockage, weak bladder muscles, medicines, or nerve disease.

Retention Time

The time a substance takes to pass through a laboratory separation system from injection until it is detected. Comparing it with a tested reference can help identify a substance, but timing alone is not definitive proof.

Rete Testis

A network of small spaces inside the testis that collects sperm from the seminiferous tubules and passes them to the small ducts leading to the epididymis.

Reticular

Net-like or arranged in a network pattern, describing the appearance or distribution of a skin lesion, rash, or vascular pattern.

Reticular Activating System

A network of brain structures that helps maintain wakefulness, alertness, attention, and transitions between sleep and waking. Damage or severe disturbance can cause unusual sleepiness, reduced awareness, or coma.

Reticular Dermis

The deeper layer of the dermis containing dense connective tissue, collagen, elastin, blood vessels, nerves, glands, and hair follicles.

Reticular Erythematous Mucinosis

A rare primary cutaneous mucinosis presenting with erythematous, reticulated macules and plaques with dermal mucin accumulation on the mid-chest and upper back in middle-aged individuals, exacerbated by ultraviolet light exposure.

Alternate Names:
REM Syndrome; Plaque-like Cutaneous Mucinosis

Reticular Formation

A network of nerve cells in the brainstem that helps control alertness, sleep, attention, muscle tone, posture, breathing, heart function, and responses to pain.

Reticulin

A network-forming type of collagen that supports bone marrow, liver, lymph nodes, and other organs.

Reticulocyte

An immature red blood cell that has been freshly

produced and released from the bone marrow into the circulating bloodstream. Reticulocytes normally develop into mature red blood cells within one to two days. Measuring the number of reticulocytes in a blood sample allows doctors to evaluate how actively and effectively the bone marrow is producing new red blood cells, helping diagnose causes of anemia or assess recovery after blood loss.

Alternate Names:
Reticulocytes

Reticulocyte Count

The number or percentage of immature red blood cells in blood. It reflects recent bone- marrow red-cell production and helps assess anemia, especially when interpreted with the hemoglobin and clinical context.

Reticulocyte Production Index

A calculated measure that adjusts the reticulocyte percentage for the degree of anemia and the longer time immature reticulocytes spend in the bloodstream. It helps assess whether the bone marrow is producing enough red blood cells; interpretation depends on the clinical context and laboratory method.

Alternate Names:
RPI; Corrected Reticulocyte Count

Reticulocytes

Plural form; see *Reticulocyte*.

Reticulocytopenia

An abnormally low reticulocyte count indicating reduced effective red-cell production, which may occur with marrow failure, nutrient deficiency, inflammation, or kidney disease.

Reticulocytosis

Reticulocytosis is an increased number of immature red blood cells in blood, usually indicating stimulated marrow production after blood loss or hemolysis.

Reticulo-Endothelial System

Alternate spelling; see *Reticuloendothelial System*.

Reticuloendothelial System

An older term for the body's network of phagocytic cells, especially monocytes and tissue macrophages, that remove microbes, particles, and worn-out cells from tissues and blood. The term is imprecise because the originally proposed system included cells that are not phagocytes; modern usage favors *mononuclear phagocyte system*.

Reticulophagy

A cell-cleaning process that removes worn or damaged parts of the endoplasmic reticulum, the cell's internal membrane network. The material is broken down and recycled, helping cells control quality and respond to stress.

Reticulum

A network-like structure; in anatomy or cell biology it may refer to a tissue network, endoplasmic reticulum, or ruminant stomach compartment.

Retina

The light-sensitive neural tissue lining the back of the eye that converts light into nerve signals.

Retina Disorder

A disease affecting the retina, including vascular, degenerative, inflammatory, infectious, traumatic, inherited, or neoplastic conditions that can impair vision.

Retina Hemorrhage

Bleeding within or beneath the retina caused by vascular disease, diabetes, hypertension, trauma, retinal vein occlusion, inflammation, or other disorders.

Retinal Artery Occlusion

Blockage of a central or branch artery supplying the retina, reducing blood flow and causing retinal ischemia. It typically causes sudden, painless vision loss in one eye or loss of part of the visual field; a

central retinal artery occlusion is considered an eye stroke.

Retinal Cone

A light-sensing cell in the retina that provides color vision and sharp detail, especially in daylight. Damage to cone cells can reduce color perception and central vision.

Retinal Damage

Injury or disease affecting the retina, potentially causing blurred vision, field loss, flashes, floaters, or permanent visual impairment.

Retinal Degeneration

Progressive damage or loss of light-sensitive cells in the retina at the back of the eye. It may cause blurred or reduced central vision, night blindness, or loss of side vision and can result from inherited disease, aging, or other injury.

Retinaldehyde

A form of vitamin A used in the eye's light-sensing cycle. Light changes it inside photoreceptor cells, helping start the nerve signals that allow vision.

Retinal Detachment

Separation of the light-sensitive retina from the supporting retinal pigment epithelium beneath it. A rhegmatogenous detachment follows a retinal break, a tractional detachment results from scar tissue pulling on the retina, and an exudative detachment results from fluid collecting beneath it. It can cause flashes, floaters, a curtain-like shadow, or reduced vision.

Retinal Detachment Repair

Surgical or pneumatic treatment to close retinal breaks and reattach the retina. Techniques include vitrectomy, scleral buckling, and pneumatic retinopexy, selected according to the type and location of detachment.

Alternate Names:
Retinal Detachment Surgery

Retinal Diseases

Disorders that damage the retina, the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye. They may cause flashes, floaters, distorted vision, blind spots, night-vision problems, or gradual or sudden sight loss.

Retinal Disorders

Diseases affecting the light-sensing layer at the back of the eye. Causes include blood-vessel problems, inherited conditions, aging, inflammation, infection, injury, and cancer, potentially causing blurred vision or blindness.

Retinal Dysplasia

Abnormal development and arrangement of the retina, the light-sensing layer at the back of the eye. It may impair vision and can occur with conditions present from birth, genetic disorders, or problems affecting development before birth.

Retinal Dystrophy

Gradual loss or damage of retinal cells, often caused by an inherited condition. It may begin with night blindness, difficulty seeing in dim light, or loss of side vision and can progress to serious sight impairment.

Retinal Fold

A retinal fold is a crease or ridge in the retina caused by traction, developmental abnormality, detachment, swelling, or another ocular process.

Retinal Fundus

The inside back surface of the eye viewed during fundoscopy, including the retina, optic nerve, macula, and retinal blood vessels.

Retinal Ganglion

A nerve cell in the retina that collects signals from other retinal cells and sends them through the optic nerve to the brain. It is essential for carrying visual information out of the eye.

Retinal Hemorrhages

Bleeding in the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye. It may result from diabetes, high blood

pressure, injury, bleeding disorders, or increased pressure in the skull; in infants and children, the pattern can help distinguish among causes.

Retinal Implant

An implanted visual prosthesis that detects or processes light and electrically stimulates remaining retinal or visual-pathway cells in selected severe retinal disorders. It provides limited visual information and is distinct from an intraocular lens.

Retinal Ischemia

Too little blood and oxygen reaching the retina, often because a retinal artery is blocked or blood-vessel disease is severe. It may cause sudden, painless sight loss and is an emergency because prolonged injury can become permanent.

Retinal Laser Photocoagulation

An ophthalmic procedure utilizing targeted laser energy to induce localized thermal denaturation of retinal tissue. Widely used to seal microvascular leakages in diabetic macular edema, ablate ischemic peripheral retina in proliferative diabetic retinopathy, or secure retinal tears to prevent rhegmatogenous retinal detachment.

Alternate Names:
Laser Photocoagulation; Retinal Laser Therapy

Retinal Layers

The organized layers of nerve cells, supporting cells, and blood vessels that make up the retina. Together they detect light, begin visual processing, and send signals through the optic nerve to the brain.

Retinal Macula

The macula is the central region of the retina responsible for detailed straight-ahead vision, reading, and color discrimination.

Retinal Neoplasm

A retinal neoplasm is an abnormal growth arising in or near the retina, such as retinoblastoma or a metastatic tumor.

Retinal Neovascularization

Abnormal growth of new blood vessels on the retinal surface or extending from the retina toward the vitreous, usually in response to retinal ischemia. It occurs in proliferative diabetic retinopathy and other ischemic retinal disorders; fragile vessels may bleed or form scar tissue that pulls on the retina.

Alternate Names:
Retinal Neovascularisation

Retinal Neurodegeneration

Progressive dysfunction and loss of retinal neurons, such as photoreceptors or retinal ganglion cells, that can impair vision. It occurs in different diseases, including inherited retinal degenerations and glaucoma; the cells affected and course depend on the underlying condition.

Retinal Perforation

A full-thickness hole or tear in the retina. Fluid can pass through the opening and separate the retina from the tissue beneath it, causing flashes, floaters, or loss of vision.

Retinal Pigment

Retinal pigment refers to melanin-containing pigment in the retinal pigment epithelium, which supports photoreceptors and absorbs excess light.

Retinal Pigment Epithelium

A layer of cells beneath the retina that supports the light-sensing cells, absorbs extra light, and helps remove worn-out cell material.

Retinal Prosthesis

An implanted device designed to provide limited visual signals when the retina is severely damaged. A camera and electronic system stimulate remaining visual pathways; it may provide light or simple pattern perception, not normal sight.

Retinal Racemose Hemangioma

A congenital retinal arteriovenous malformation in which dilated, tortuous arteries connect directly to veins without an intervening capillary bed. It

is usually unilateral and may occur alone or with an arteriovenous malformation of the brain, as in Wyburn–Mason syndrome; effects on vision vary.

Alternate Names:
Racemose Angioma; Retinal Arteriovenous Malformation

Retinal Tear

A full-thickness break in the light-sensitive retina, often caused by traction as the vitreous gel separates from it. Fluid can pass through the break and cause retinal detachment; flashes or new floaters may occur.

Retinal Vasculitis

Inflammation of blood vessels in the retina. Leaking or blocked vessels can cause blurred vision, bleeding, swelling, or permanent sight loss; it may be linked to infection, autoimmune disease, or inflammation elsewhere in the body.

Retinal Vein Occlusion

Blockage of the central retinal vein or one of its branches, causing blood to back up in the retina. Retinal bleeding, macular edema, or reduced blood flow may blur vision and, in severe cases, lead to growth of abnormal blood vessels.

Retronychia

A condition in which the upper end of a nail plate becomes trapped in the skin fold at the nail base, often after injury or repeated pressure. A new nail may grow underneath the old one, causing pain, swelling, redness, or overgrowth of tissue at the nail fold, most often on a big toe.

Retinitis

Inflammation or infection of the retina, the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye. It may cause blurred vision, floaters, flashes, or loss of sight and can lead to permanent visual damage.

Retinitis Pigmentosa

A group of inherited retinal disorders in which light-sensing cells gradually degenerate, usually first affecting rod cells. It commonly causes night blindness and progressive loss of peripheral vision; central vision may decline later.

Retinoblastoma

The most common eye cancer in infants and young children, starting in the retina, the light-sensitive tissue at the back of the eye. It is caused by genetic changes in the *RB1* gene, which can be inherited from a parent or occur spontaneously during fetal development. The most frequent sign is a white reflection or glow in the pupil (leukocoria), often seen in photographs taken with a flash instead of the typical red eye, along with crossed or misaligned eyes (strabismus), redness, or decreased vision.

Alternate Names:
Childhood Eye Cancer Retinal Glioma Malignant Retinoblastoma

Retinoblastoma Protein

A protein made from the RB1 gene that helps prevent cells from dividing when they should not. Loss of its protective function can contribute to retinoblastoma and other cancers.

Retinoic Acid

An active form of vitamin A that helps control how cells develop and which genes they use. Related medicines are used for selected skin conditions and some cancers but can cause irritation or serious pregnancy risks.

Retinoid

A member of a family of natural or synthetic chemical compounds related to vitamin A that play a key role in regulating how skin and other epithelial cells grow, divide, and shed. Retinoids are widely used in medicine to treat various skin conditions, such as severe acne and psoriasis, as well as certain blood and skin cancers, but their use requires caution because they can cause severe birth defects if taken during pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Retinoids

Retinoids

Plural form; see *Retinoid*.

Retinol

A form of vitamin A needed for vision, healthy skin and body linings, growth, and immune function. It comes from animal foods and some supplements; too much can be harmful, especially during pregnancy.

Retinopathy

Damage or disease of the retina, the light-sensing layer at the back of the eye. Diabetes, high blood pressure, prematurity, blocked vessels, aging, inflammation, and inherited conditions can cause it and may lead to sight loss.

Retinopathy Of Prematurity

A disease of premature infants in which retinal blood vessels develop abnormally after birth. Mild disease may regress, but abnormal vessels can scar and pull on the retina, causing detachment and permanent vision loss. Risk is greatest with extreme prematurity and very low birth weight.

Retinoschisis

Splitting between layers of the retina. It may result from aging or an inherited condition and can cause reduced sharpness or loss of part of the visual field; it differs from retinal detachment but may look similar on examination.

Retinoscope

An instrument that shines light into the eye to estimate refractive error by observing how light reflects from the retina.

Retinoscopy

An eye examination that uses a retinoscope to estimate refractive error by observing how light reflects from the retina.

Retirement

Retirement is withdrawal from regular employment or a career; changes in income, activity, social contact, and health coverage can affect wellbeing.

Retracted Nipple

Alternate name; see *Nipple Inversion Or Retraction*.

Retractile Testicle

Alternate name; see *Retractile Testis*.

Retractile Testis

A testis that moves between the scrotum and groin because of a strong reflex but can be brought into the scrotum. It may later become an ascending (undescended) testis.

Retractor

A surgical instrument used to hold tissue or an organ aside so the area can be seen and reached during an examination or operation. Some retractors are held by hand; others stay in place by themselves.

Retrobulbar Hemorrhage

Bleeding behind the eyeball within the orbit, often after trauma or surgery, that can rapidly increase orbital pressure and threaten vision.

Retrobulbar Neuritis

Inflammation of the optic nerve behind the eyeball, causing reduced or blurred vision and pain, especially when the eye moves. It may be associated with multiple sclerosis or another immune condition and can cause lasting vision loss.

Retroesophageal

Retroesophageal means located behind the esophagus, such as a mass, lymph node, vessel, or collection in the posterior mediastinum.

Retrognathia

Retrognathia is backward positioning of the lower jaw relative to the upper jaw and may affect facial structure, bite, airway, or sleep breathing.

Retrograde

Moving backward or against the normal direction, such as retrograde amnesia or retrograde blood flow.

Retrograde Amnesia

Loss of memory for events that occurred before an injury, illness, or other triggering event, with variable preservation of more remote memories.

Retrograde Cystography

Retrograde cystography uses contrast placed through the urethra to outline the bladder and detect leaks, injury, or structural abnormalities.

Retrograde Degeneration

Breakdown of a nerve fiber that spreads back toward the nerve cell body after the fiber is injured. It can reduce movement, sensation, or organ function depending on which nerve is affected and how severe the injury is.

Retrograde Ejaculation

A condition in which semen enters the bladder instead of leaving through the penis during orgasm. It may cause little or no semen to appear and can result from diabetes, surgery, nerve problems, or medicines. It may affect fertility.

Retrograde Intrarenal Surgery

RIRS is a minimally invasive procedure using a flexible scope passed through the urinary tract to inspect and fragment or remove kidney stones.

Retrograde Urethrogram

An X-ray study that outlines the urethra after contrast material is introduced through its opening. It can show narrowing, tears, blockage, or abnormal connections, especially after suspected urethral injury.

Retroperitoneal Fibrosis

Formation of abnormal scar-like tissue in the space behind the abdominal organs. It often surrounds the tubes draining urine from the kidneys, causing back or abdominal pain, urine blockage, and reduced kidney function; medicines, immune disease, or cancer can cause it.

Retroperitoneal Hematoma

A collection of extravasated blood within the retroperitoneal anatomical space, commonly provoked by pelvic fractures, penetrating or blunt abdominal trauma, rupture of an abdominal aortic aneurysm, or femoral vascular catheterization; classified into zones I (central), II (flank), and III (pelvic).

Retroperitoneal Hemorrhage

Bleeding in the space behind the abdominal lining. It may follow injury, blood-thinning treatment, a procedure, or rupture of a blood vessel and can cause back or abdominal pain, weakness, low blood pressure, and life-threatening blood loss.

Retroperitoneal Inflammation

Retroperitoneal inflammation is inflammatory disease in the space behind the peritoneum, caused by infection, pancreatitis, urinary disease, trauma, medicines, or fibrosis.

Retroperitoneal Neoplasm

A retroperitoneal neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the tissue space behind the abdominal lining and may be benign or malignant.

Retroperitoneal Space

The space behind the peritoneal lining of the abdomen. It contains the kidneys, adrenal glands, ureters, major blood vessels, and parts of the pancreas and bowel.

Retroperitoneum

See *Retroperitoneal Space*.

Retropharyngeal Abscess

A pocket of pus in the tissues behind the throat, usually after infection or injury. It can cause fever, severe throat or neck pain, trouble swallowing, drooling, noisy breathing, or a stiff neck. It can block the breathing passage.

Retropharyngeal Space

A potential fascial space in the neck located between the buccopharyngeal fascia of the pharynx anteriorly and the alar layer of the prevertebral fascia posteriorly, extending from the skull base down into the superior mediastinum (providing an anatomical conduit for the spread of retropharyngeal abscesses into the mediastinum).

Retrospective Studies

See *Retrospective Study*.

Retrospective Study

A study that examines existing records or past exposures to investigate disease causes, treatments, or outcomes. It can be efficient, but missing information and differences between groups may limit reliable conclusions.

Retrosternal Thyroid Surgery

An operation to remove part or all of a thyroid gland that extends behind the breastbone. It may relieve pressure on the airway or swallowing tube and requires planning around nearby nerves, blood vessels, and the parathyroid glands.

Retrotracheal

Retrotracheal means located behind the trachea, such as a mass, lymph node, vessel, or collection in the posterior mediastinum.

Retrotransposition

The copying and insertion of a genetic sequence into a new place in the genome using an RNA copy as an intermediate. New insertions can be harmless or disrupt a gene and cause disease.

Retroversion

Backward tilting or turning of an organ, especially the uterus toward the spine. A backward-tilted uterus is often normal, but in some people it is linked with pain, endometriosis, or difficult examinations.

Retroversion Of The Uterus

A uterine position in which the uterus tilts backward toward the spine; it is often a normal variant but can be associated with pain or endometriosis.

Retroviridae

A family of RNA viruses that make a DNA copy of their genetic material and insert it into infected cells. HIV is a member; these viruses can cause persistent infection, immune disease, or cancer.

Retroviridae Infection

An infection caused by a retrovirus, which may persist through genomic integration and cause immune, neurologic, or malignant disease.

Retrovirus

A type of virus that uses RNA as its genetic material instead of DNA. It uses an enzyme called reverse transcriptase to make a DNA copy of its RNA. This copy can become part of the DNA of an infected cell, allowing the virus to make more copies. HIV is an example of a retrovirus.

Rett Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder that affects brain development and occurs almost exclusively in girls. Development may appear typical for the first 6 to 18 months, followed by loss of previously learned language, purposeful hand use, coordination, or movement. Repeated hand movements such as handwringing or clapping are common. Slowed head growth, seizures, breathing changes, feeding problems, sleep problems, and curvature of the spine (scoliosis) may occur. Most cases are caused by a new change in the *MECP2* gene; rare males with related gene changes can also be affected.

Return Of Spontaneous Circulation

Restoration of a sustained heartbeat and blood flow after cardiac arrest, shown by a pulse, blood pressure, or other signs of circulation. Intensive post-arrest care then supports breathing, blood pressure, brain function, temperature, and treatment of the cause.

Reuptake

The removal of a released nerve chemical from the space between nerve cells by returning it to the releasing cell or taking it into a nearby cell. This limits and ends the signal.

Revalidation

Formal reassessment that a healthcare professional remains fit, competent, and up to date to practice.

Revascularisation

Restoration of blood flow to an organ or limb by a procedure such as angioplasty, stenting, or surgical bypass.

Revascularization

Restoration of blood flow to an area by bypass surgery, balloon treatment, stent placement, or another procedure. It can relieve symptoms, preserve tissue, and reduce damage caused by a blocked or narrowed vessel.

Revascularization Surgery

Revascularization surgery restores blood flow around a blocked or narrowed vessel, such as in coronary artery bypass or limb bypass surgery.

Reverberation Artifact

An ultrasound image error caused by repeated reflections, sometimes reduced by changing the angle or using specialized imaging.

Reversal Learning

Reversal learning is the ability to change a learned response when the previously rewarded or correct choice is no longer so.

Reverse Total Shoulder Replacement

Shoulder-replacement surgery that places the rounded joint surface on the shoulder blade and the socket on the upper-arm implant. This changes shoulder mechanics and can help when severe arthritis occurs with an irreparable rotator cuff.

Reverse Transcriptase

An enzyme that synthesizes DNA using RNA as a template.

Reverse Transcriptase Inhibitor

A class of antiviral medications used primarily to treat infections caused by retroviruses, such as HIV, and hepadnaviruses, such as hepatitis B. These drugs work by blocking reverse transcriptase, a crucial viral enzyme that the virus requires to convert its genetic material into a form that can integrate into human host cells and replicate, thereby suppressing viral levels in the body.

Alternate Names:
Reverse Transcriptase Inhibitors; RTI; RTIs

Reverse Transcriptase Inhibitors

Plural form; see *Reverse Transcriptase Inhibitor*.

Reverse Transcription

The production of DNA using RNA as a template, carried out by reverse transcriptase. Some viruses use this process to copy their genetic material, and laboratories use it to study RNA.

Reverse Trendelenburg Position

A supine position in which the head and upper body are elevated higher than the feet. The head-up tilt uses gravity to shift abdominal organs downward, improving surgical visualization during head, neck, upper gastrointestinal, and laparoscopic procedures while facilitating ventilation.

Alternate Names:
Head-Up Tilt Position; Anti-Trendelenburg Position

Reversible Cell Injury

Temporary cell damage that can resolve when the harmful cause is removed. Cells may swell, store excess fat, or produce less energy, but their membranes and genetic material remain sufficiently intact to recover.

Revision Arthroplasty

Surgical replacement, exchange, or repair of a failed or painful joint prosthesis. Indications include infection, aseptic loosening, instability, periprosthetic fracture, wear, and recurrent dislocation.

Revision Total Hip Arthroplasty

Surgery to remove and replace some or all parts of a previous hip replacement that have loosened, worn out, become infected, dislocated repeatedly, or failed. It is more complex than first-time replacement and may require bone reconstruction.

Revision Total Knee Arthroplasty

Surgery to remove and replace parts of a previous knee replacement because of loosening, wear, infection, instability, stiffness, or persistent pain. It may require specialized implants or bone grafting and has higher risks than the first operation.

Reye-Johnson Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Reye Syndrome*.

Reye's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Reye Syndrome*.

Reye Syndrome

A rare, serious illness that causes sudden brain dysfunction and liver injury, often in children recovering from a viral infection. Aspirin exposure during the illness is associated with increased risk.

Alternate Names:
Reye-Johnson Syndrome; Fatty Liver with Encephalopathy

Reynolds Pentad

The combination of Charcot's triad—fever or chills, right upper abdominal pain, and jaundice— with hypotension and altered mental status. It is a classic presentation of severe acute cholangitis, but occurs in only a minority of cases; its absence does not exclude the disease.

Rezafungin

A long-acting echinocandin antifungal medicine that inhibits fungal cell-wall synthesis. It is used for selected invasive candidiasis infections; its long duration permits an intermittent dosing schedule under specialist supervision.

R-Factor

A plasmid carrying one or more genes that make bacteria resistant to antibiotics. Some R factors can transfer between bacteria, spreading drug resistance.

Rgs Proteins

Regulators of G-protein signaling are proteins that speed the switch-off of signals from G-protein-coupled receptors. They help control responses to hormones, neurotransmitters, and other signals and may influence disease when altered.

Rhabdoid Tumor

A rare, fast-growing cancer that usually affects infants and young children. It may begin in the kidney, brain, or other tissues; changes in genes that control cell growth, especially SMARCB1, are common.

Rhabdomyolysis

A serious medical condition caused by the rapid, extensive breakdown of damaged skeletal muscle tissue. When muscle cells rupture, their internal proteins and electrolytes—especially a protein called myoglobin—spill directly into the bloodstream. This surge of muscle proteins can clog the filtering units of the kidneys, potentially leading to acute kidney injury or failure. Common triggers include severe physical trauma or crush injuries, extreme overexertion, prolonged pressure on muscles from immobilization, heatstroke, or certain medications, classically causing severe muscle pain, weakness, and dark tea- or cola-colored urine.

Alternate Names:
Rhabdomyo; Acute Muscle Breakdown; Myoglobinuria Syndrome

Rhabdomyolysis And AKI

Severe muscle breakdown releases muscle proteins and salts, potentially causing acute kidney injury, abnormal body salts, and abnormal heart rhythms. Findings may include muscle pain, weakness, dark urine, and a high creatine kinase level.

Rhabdomyoma

A usually noncancerous tumor made of heart-muscle cells, seen mainly in infants and children. It is strongly associated with tuberous sclerosis and may shrink on its own, but large or multiple tumors can block blood flow or disturb the heart rhythm.

Rhabdomyosarcoma

Rhabdomyosarcoma is a malignant tumor showing skeletal-muscle differentiation, occurring most often in children but also in adults.

Rhabdomyosarcoma Pathology

A malignant mesenchymal tumor showing skeletal-muscle differentiation. Histologic patterns include embryonal, alveolar, spindle-cell, and pleomorphic forms, with primitive cells, rhabdomyoblasts, and variable myogenin or MyoD1 expression.

Rhegmatogenous Retinal Detachment

The most common type of retinal detachment, caused by a hole or tear that lets the eye's internal fluid pass beneath the retina. It can cause flashes, floaters, a curtain-like shadow, or sight loss.

Rhesus Factor

See *Rh Factor*.

Rhesus Incompatibility

Rhesus incompatibility occurs when an RhD-negative pregnant person forms antibodies against RhD-positive fetal red cells, risking haemolytic disease in a later or affected pregnancy; anti-D immunoglobulin prevents sensitization.

Rhesus System

The Rh blood-group system, a group of inherited red-cell antigens including D, C, c, E, and e. RhD status is commonly reported as positive or negative and is important in transfusion compatibility and prevention of hemolytic disease of the fetus and newborn.

Rheumatic Chorea

Involuntary, irregular, fidgety movements caused by an immune reaction after group A streptococcal infection. It is a feature of acute rheumatic fever and may affect the face, arms, legs, speech, or handwriting.

Rheumatic Disease

A broad group of disorders affecting joints, muscles, bones, connective tissue, or immune function, including arthritis and lupus.

Rheumatic Fever

An inflammatory disease that can develop as a complication of an untreated or poorly treated throat infection caused by group A *Streptococcus* bacteria (strep throat or scarlet fever). In susceptible individuals, the immune system produces antibodies against the bacteria that mistakenly react against the body's own tissues, causing inflammation in the heart, joints, skin, and central nervous system. Symptoms include painful, swollen, migratory joint pain, fever, chest pain, rapid heartbeats, and jerky uncoordinated movements. Inflammation of the heart valves can lead to long-term scarring and chronic rheumatic heart disease.

Alternate Names:
Acute Rheumatic Fever; ARF; Rheumatic Heart Disease Precursor

Rheumatic Heart Disease

Permanent damage to heart valves after rheumatic fever, an immune reaction following group A streptococcal throat infection. It most often affects the mitral valve and can cause breathlessness, tiredness, swelling, abnormal rhythms, or heart failure.

Rheumatism

Pain, stiffness, or discomfort in joints and surrounding soft tissues.

Rheumatoid Arthritis

A chronic autoimmune disease in which the body's immune system mistakenly attacks the lining of the joints (the synovium). This attack causes persistent inflammation, leading to joint pain, warmth, swelling, and morning stiffness that lasts for hours, typically affecting the same joints on both sides of the body—especially the hands, wrists, and feet. Over time, chronic inflammation can erode bone and destroy cartilage, causing joint deformities and weakness, and may also affect other organs such as the heart and lungs.

Alternate Names:
RA; Atrophic Arthritis

Rheumatoid Arthritis Of The Foot

Inflammation from rheumatoid arthritis affecting joints in the foot or ankle. It can cause pain, swelling, and stiffness, often in matching joints on

both feet, and may damage joints or change foot shape over time.

Rheumatoid Arthritis Of The Hip

Inflammation of the hip joint caused by rheumatoid arthritis, an immune disease that can affect joints throughout the body. It may cause pain, stiffness, and swelling and can damage the joint over time.

Rheumatoid Arthritis of the Cervical Spine

Alternate name; see *Cervical Spine Involvement in Rheumatoid Arthritis*.

Rheumatoid Arthritis and Pregnancy

Rheumatoid arthritis often changes during pregnancy and may flare after delivery. Care balances disease control, joint function, medication safety, contraception or fertility goals, and fetal or newborn considerations, with coordinated rheumatology and obstetric review.

Rheumatoid Arthritis Cause Gastrointestinal Issues

Rheumatoid arthritis can affect the gastrointestinal system indirectly through inflammation, associated autoimmune disease, reduced mobility, or medicines such as nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs. Abdominal pain, bleeding, persistent diarrhea, or weight loss may reflect gastrointestinal disease rather than arthritis itself.

Rheumatoid Arthritis Inflammation Of The Brain

Direct brain inflammation is uncommon in rheumatoid arthritis, but vasculitis, medication effects, infection, stroke, or another autoimmune process can cause neurologic symptoms. Confusion, seizure, weakness, severe headache, or vision change can signal a serious neurologic complication.

Rheumatoid Arthritis (RA)

Alternate name; see *Rheumatoid Arthritis*.

Rheumatoid Factor

An antibody that mistakenly recognizes part of another antibody. A blood test may support the diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis, but it can also be positive in other diseases or in healthy people.

Rheumatoid Factor Test

A blood test that detects rheumatoid factor autoantibodies, frequently ordered in the evaluation of rheumatoid arthritis and other autoimmune disorders; see *Rheumatoid Factor*.

Rheumatoid Lung Disease

Lung involvement associated with rheumatoid arthritis, including interstitial lung disease, pleural disease, nodules, or airway abnormalities.

Rheumatoid Nodule

A firm, non-tender subcutaneous inflammatory nodule occurring in approximately 20–30% of patients with seropositive rheumatoid arthritis, characteristically located over pressure points and extensor surfaces (such as the olecranon process, Achilles tendon, and proximal forearm) or occasionally in internal viscera (lungs, pleura, pericardium). Histologically characterized by central fibrinoid necrosis surrounded by a palisade of CD68+ histiocytes and tissue macrophages enclosed in a fibrous capsule with lymphocytic infiltrate; correlates strongly with high-titer rheumatoid factor, anti-CCP antibodies, and severe erosive disease.

Alternate Names:
Rheumatoid Nodules

Rheumatoid Nodules

Plural form; see *Rheumatoid Nodule*.

Rheumatoid Pneumoconiosis

Rheumatoid pneumoconiosis is lung disease involving rheumatoid arthritis and dust-related lung nodules, historically called Caplan syndrome.

Rheumatoid Synovitis

Long-lasting immune inflammation of the tissue lining a joint in rheumatoid arthritis. It causes pain

and swelling and can gradually damage cartilage, bone, and joint movement.

Rheumatoid Vasculitis

Inflammation of small or medium-sized blood vessels associated with rheumatoid arthritis. It can reduce blood flow and affect the skin, nerves, eyes, or internal organs.

Rheumatologist

A medical doctor who diagnoses and treats diseases affecting joints, muscles, bones, and connective tissues, especially autoimmune and inflammatory conditions such as rheumatoid arthritis, lupus, gout, and vasculitis.

Rheumatology

The medical specialty focused on inflammatory, autoimmune, and other disorders of the joints, muscles, bones, and connective tissues. It includes conditions such as rheumatoid arthritis, lupus, vasculitis, gout, and systemic sclerosis.

Rh Factor

A system of antigens on the surface of red blood cells, especially the D antigen. A person is Rh-positive when the D antigen is present and Rh-negative when it is absent. Rh incompatibility can affect pregnancy and transfusion safety.

Alternate Names:
Rh D Antigen; Rhesus Antigen

Rh Immune Globulin

An antibody medicine given to eligible RhD-negative pregnant people to reduce the chance of forming antibodies against RhD-positive fetal red blood cells. It is also used after some pregnancy events and in selected transfusion settings.

Rh Incompatibility

An immune reaction that can occur when an Rh-negative pregnant person carries an Rh-positive fetus and forms antibodies against fetal red blood cells. Anti-D immune globulin can prevent sensitization.

Rhinencephalon

An older term for brain regions involved mainly in smell and closely connected with emotion and memory. Modern anatomy usually names the individual structures instead of using this broad term.

Rhinitis

Inflammation or irritation of the lining of the nose. It can cause a blocked or runny nose, sneezing, itching, and reduced smell and may result from allergy, infection, smoke, strong smells, medicines, or other triggers.

Rhinitis Medicamentosa

Persistent or worsening nasal congestion caused by prolonged or excessive use of topical nasal decongestant sprays, such as oxymetazoline. The duration that can trigger it varies.

Alternate Names:
Rebound Nasal Congestion; Topical Decongestant Rhinitis

Rhinocephaly

A very rare birth defect involving severe abnormal development of the face and forebrain, with a nose-like structure that may lie unusually high or between the eyes. It is usually associated with major neurologic and developmental abnormalities.

Rhinocerebral Mucormycosis

A rapidly progressing fungal infection of the nose and sinuses that can spread to the eye socket or brain. It is caused by Mucorales fungi and occurs mainly in people with severe immune suppression or diabetic ketoacidosis; blood-vessel invasion can cause tissue death.

Alternate Names:
Invasive Rhinocerebral Zygomycosis

Rhinophyma

Progressive thickening and enlargement of the nose caused by long-standing changes often associated with rosacea. It may produce a rough, irregular appearance and can sometimes interfere with breathing or require surgical treatment.

Rhinoplasty

Surgery to reshape, repair, or reconstruct the nose for breathing, injury, birth differences, or appearance. Recovery includes swelling and bruising, and results depend on anatomy, technique, healing, and patient goals.

Rhinorrhea

Excessive watery or mucoid discharge from the nose, commonly caused by infection, allergy, irritants, or changes in temperature.

Rhinorrhoea

British spelling of rhinorrhea, meaning drainage of watery or mucus-like fluid from the nose. Causes include allergy, infection, irritation, and rarely a cerebrospinal-fluid leak.

Rhinoscleroma

A chronic, slowly progressive granulomatous infection of the nose and upper airway caused by Klebsiella rhinoscleromatis. It may progress from foul-smelling discharge and obstruction to scarring, deformity, and airway narrowing and usually needs prolonged antibiotics.

Rhinoscopy

Examination of the nasal cavity and nasopharynx using an instrument or endoscope to assess the mucosa, septum, turbinates, masses, bleeding, or obstruction.

Rhinosporidiosis

A chronic localized granulomatous disease of the mucous membranes caused by Rhinosporidium seeberi, an aquatic protistan parasite in the clade Mesomycetozoea, endemic primarily to rural wetland communities in India and Sri Lanka. It classically manifests in the anterior nasal cavity or nasopharynx as painless, friable, highly vascular, sessile or pedunculated polypoid lesions with a characteristic "strawberry-like" appearance dotted with visible white spherules (sporangia), causing nasal obstruction, epistaxis, and foreign-body sensation.

Alternate Names:
Nasal Rhinosporidiosis; Rhinosporidium Seeberi Infection

Rhinovirus

A common family of respiratory viruses that serves as the predominant cause of the common cold. The virus infects the mucosal lining of the nose and throat, multiplying best at the slightly cooler temperatures found in the nasal passages. It typically causes symptoms such as a runny or congested nose, sneezing, scratchy or sore throat, mild cough, and headache, and can trigger worsening breathing problems in people with asthma or chronic lung disease.

Alternate Names:
Rhinoviruses; Human Rhinovirus; HRV

Rhinovirus A

A species group of rhinoviruses that commonly causes the common cold and can worsen asthma or trigger wheezing.

Rhinovirus C

A rhinovirus group associated with common-cold symptoms and, in some children, more severe wheezing or lower-respiratory illness.

Rhinoviruses

Plural form; see *Rhinovirus*.

Rh Isoimmunization

Maternal alloantibody production against fetal Rh D-positive red blood cells in an Rh D-negative mother, occurring when fetal RBCs enter the maternal circulation (fetomaternal hemorrhage).

Rhizomucor

A genus of molds that can cause mucormycosis, especially in people with diabetes, neutropenia, or severe immune suppression.

Rhizomucor Pusillus

A mold that can cause invasive mucormycosis involving the lungs, sinuses, skin, or other organs in severely immunocompromised people.

Rhizopus

A genus of molds that includes important causes of mucormycosis, a rapidly invasive infection of sinuses, lungs, skin, or other tissues.

Rhizopus Oryzae

A mold, also called Rhizopus arrhizus, that is a common cause of invasive mucormycosis.

Rhizotomy

A procedure that cuts or heats selected nerve roots to reduce severe pain, muscle stiffness, or abnormal reflexes. It is used only in carefully selected cases because it can cause permanent numbness, weakness, or other nerve problems.

Rhodium

A chemical element used in industrial and dental materials; its compounds can irritate tissues and may cause allergic reactions.

Rhodococcus

A genus of gram-positive bacteria that includes Rhodococcus equi, an opportunistic pathogen causing pneumonia mainly in immunocompromised people.

Rhodococcus Equi

A gram-positive bacterium that can cause cavitary pneumonia and disseminated infection, especially in people with advanced immune suppression.

Rhodopsin

A light-sensitive protein in rod cells of the retina that enables vision in dim light.

Rhodospirillaceae

A family of metabolically diverse bacteria found in soil and water; some species carry out photosynthesis or nitrogen fixation.

Rhodospirillum

A genus of spiral-shaped aquatic bacteria capable of photosynthesis or nitrogen fixation; human infection is rare.

Rhombencephalon

The hindbrain region of an early embryo. It develops into the pons, medulla, cerebellum, and related structures that help control breathing, balance, movement, swallowing, and other essential functions.

Rhonchi

Low-pitched, continuous breathing sounds caused by air moving through narrowed or mucus-filled larger airways. They may change after coughing.

Rhonchus

A low-pitched, continuous breathing sound caused by air moving through narrowed or mucus-filled larger airways.

Alternate Names:
Rhonchi

Rhubarb Leaves Poisoning

Illness caused by eating large amounts of rhubarb leaves, which contain oxalates. Severe exposure can cause vomiting, abdominal pain, low blood calcium, or kidney injury.

Rhythm Method

A fertility-awareness method that estimates fertile days from menstrual-cycle timing to avoid or achieve pregnancy.

Rib

One of 12 paired, curved bones forming the thoracic cage, protecting the heart, lungs, and great vessels. True ribs (1–7) attach directly to the sternum via costal cartilage. False ribs (8–10) attach indirectly to the sternum via the costal cartilage of rib 7. Floating ribs (11–12) have no anterior attachment.

Alternate Names:
Costal Bone; Costa

Rib Angle

The point where a rib bends most sharply as it curves from the spine toward the front of the chest.

Ribavirin

A synthetic antiviral nucleoside analogue used for selected viral infections, often in combination with other medicines. It interferes with viral replication, and the specific regimen depends on the infection. Important risks include hemolytic anemia, which can worsen heart disease, and serious embryo-fetal toxicity; exposure during pregnancy is contraindicated.

Rib Cage

The rib cage consists of ribs, sternum, thoracic vertebrae, muscles, and connective tissues that protect chest organs and assist breathing.

Ribcage Pain

Ribcage pain may arise from muscles, ribs, joints, lungs, heart, or other organs; sudden severe pain or breathing difficulty may indicate a serious condition.

Rib Fracture

A break in one or more ribs, usually causing localized chest pain worsened by breathing, coughing, or movement and sometimes associated with injury to underlying organs.

Rib Head

The back end of a rib that joins with the bodies of one or two thoracic vertebrae.

Rib Neck

The narrowed part of a rib between its head and tubercle.

Riboflavin

A water-soluble vitamin that forms the coenzymes FAD and FMN. These cofactors participate in oxidation-reduction reactions, including electron transfer, fatty-acid oxidation, and energy metabolism.

Alternate Names:
Lactoflavin; Vitamin G

Riboflavin Deficiency

Deficiency of vitamin B2, which can cause inflammation or fissuring of the mouth and lips, sore throat, dermatitis, anemia, and other mucosal or systemic findings.

Ribonuclease

An enzyme that cuts RNA, a molecule involved in reading genetic instructions, into smaller pieces. Ribonucleases help control how long RNA lasts, recycle cell material, and protect cells from some unwanted genetic material.

Ribonuclease H

An enzyme that removes the RNA strand when RNA and DNA are joined together. Cells use it during DNA copying, and some viruses depend on related activity when making DNA from their RNA.

Ribonuclease III

An enzyme that cuts double-stranded RNA into smaller pieces. The products can help control gene activity, make proteins, or process genetic material in cells and some microorganisms.

Ribonucleic Acid

RNA is a nucleic acid that carries genetic instructions, helps make proteins, and regulates cell activity; some viruses use RNA as their genetic material.

Ribonucleoprotein

A structure made of RNA joined to one or more proteins. It helps make, process, transport, or control RNA; antibodies against certain ribonucleoproteins can occur in autoimmune diseases.

Ribonucleoside

A molecule made of a ribose sugar joined to one of the bases used in RNA. Examples include adenosine, guanosine, cytidine, and uridine; adding phosphate groups produces RNA building blocks.

Ribonucleotide Reductase

An enzyme that changes RNA building blocks into the related building blocks needed to make DNA. Cells require it to copy and repair DNA, so it is important for growth and is a target of some cancer

medicines.

Ribonucleotides

Nucleotides containing ribose sugar and RNA bases, serving as RNA building blocks and cellular energy or signaling molecules.

Ribophagy

A cell-cleaning process that breaks down some ribosomes, the structures that make proteins, so their parts can be recycled. It helps cells adjust protein production when nutrients or growth conditions change.

Ribose

A five-carbon sugar used to build RNA, ATP, and other molecules involved in storing genetic information and transferring energy. Cells make ribose from other nutrients and use it in many normal chemical processes.

Ribosomal Protein

A protein that combines with ribosomal RNA to form a ribosome, the cell structure that builds proteins. Inherited changes in some ribosomal proteins can cause bone-marrow failure or developmental syndromes.

Ribosomal RNA

RNA that forms the main structural and working part of ribosomes, the cell structures that make proteins. It helps position messenger RNA and joins amino acids together; its genes are also used in some laboratory studies to identify organisms.

Ribosome

A cellular structure made of RNA and proteins that reads messenger RNA and links amino acids together to make proteins.

Ribosome Subunit

One of the two RNA-and-protein parts of a ribosome. The small and large parts join around messenger RNA and work together to assemble amino acids into a protein.

Rib Tubercle

A small projection near the back of a rib that joins with the transverse process of a thoracic vertebra.

Richter's Syndrome

Transformation of chronic lymphocytic leukemia or small lymphocytic lymphoma into an aggressive lymphoma, most often diffuse large B-cell lymphoma.

Richter Transformation

The rapid clinico-pathological transformation of chronic lymphocytic leukemia (CLL) or small lymphocytic lymphoma (SLL) into an aggressive, high-grade diffuse large B-cell lymphoma (DLBCL), presenting with rapidly enlarging lymphadenopathy, systemic B symptoms, and elevated serum LDH.

Alternate Names:
Richter's Syndrome; High-Grade Transformation of CLL

Ricin

Ricin is a highly toxic plant protein that blocks protein synthesis; ingestion, inhalation, or injection can cause severe organ injury and death.

Rickets

A condition in children whose growing bones do not harden normally, usually because of too little vitamin D, calcium, or phosphate. It can cause weak or bowed bones, bone pain, and problems with growth.

Rickettsia

A group of small intracellular bacteria transmitted mainly by arthropods and causing diseases such as typhus and spotted fevers.

Rickettsiaceae

A family of bacteria that live inside cells and includes several organisms spread by ticks, fleas, lice, or mites. They can cause fever, rash, blood-vessel inflammation, and serious organ complications.

Rickettsia Felis

A flea-associated bacterium that can cause a spotted-

fever-like illness in people. Infection may produce fever, headache, rash, fatigue, or muscle aches and is assessed with exposure history and laboratory testing.

Rickettsia Infections

Rickettsial infections are illnesses caused by intracellular bacteria spread mainly by ticks, fleas, lice, or mites and often causing fever and rash.

Rickettsia Japonica

A bacterium spread by ticks and associated with Japanese spotted fever. Infection may cause fever, headache, rash, and a dark mark where the tick bit; treatment uses suitable antibiotics.

Rickettsialpox

An infection caused by *Rickettsia akari* and spread by house mouse mites. It may begin with a dark sore at the bite site, followed by fever and a blister-like rash.

Rickettsia Prowazekii

A bacterium that causes epidemic typhus and is mainly spread through infected body-lice feces. Disease can cause high fever, headache, rash, confusion, and serious organ complications without prompt antibiotic treatment.

Rickettsia Rickettsii

A bacterium spread by infected ticks that causes Rocky Mountain spotted fever. Fever, severe headache, rash, muscle aches, or confusion may develop; untreated infection can rapidly become life-threatening.

Rickettsia Typhi

A bacterium spread mainly by infected fleas and responsible for murine typhus. The illness commonly causes fever, headache, chills, and sometimes a rash; untreated infection can become severe.

Riddoch Phenomenon

A form of visual statuagnosia in which a patient with homonymous hemianopia or cortical blindness from an occipital lobe lesion is able to perceive moving visual targets within the blind field while remaining unable to visualize stationary, static stimuli.

Alternate Names:
Statuagnosia; Visual Motion Perception Preservation

Ridged Cranial Sutures

Raised skull seams in an infant that may reflect normal molding or premature suture fusion (craniosynostosis).

Ridged Nail

A ridged nail has longitudinal or transverse grooves in its surface, which may result from aging, trauma, inflammation, nutritional problems, or systemic disease.

Ridge Preservation

A dental procedure performed after a tooth is removed to reduce loss of the jawbone that held the tooth. Material is placed in the empty socket, sometimes with a covering, to help maintain shape for healing or a future implant.

Riedel's Thyroiditis

A rare form of thyroid inflammation in which tough scar-like tissue makes the thyroid hard and may spread into nearby structures. It can cause a neck lump, difficulty swallowing or breathing, or reduced thyroid function.

Riedel Thyroiditis

A rare, chronic fibroinflammatory disorder of the thyroid gland (an organ manifestation of IgG4-related disease) characterized by dense, invasive collagenous fibrous tissue replacing normal thyroid tissue and extending into adjacent strap muscles and trachea, presenting as a stony-hard, fixed ('woody') goiter.

Alternate Names:
Invasive Fibrous Thyroiditis; Woody Thyroiditis

Rieger Syndrome

A genetic condition affecting development of the

front of the eye and often the teeth. It may cause glaucoma, unusual teeth, or changes around the navel and can result from changes in genes such as PITX2 or FOXC1.

Riehl Melanosis (Pigmented Contact Dermatitis)

An acquired gray-brown to slate-colored facial or neck hyperpigmentation associated with contact or photocontact exposure to fragrances, cosmetics, dyes, or other chemicals. Itching or redness may precede pigmentation; patch or photopatch testing can help identify an associated trigger.

Rifabutin

A rifamycin antibiotic used mainly for selected mycobacterial infections and tuberculosis regimens; it has important drug interactions and can discolor body fluids.

Rifampicin

Alternate name; see *Rifampin*.

Rifampin

Rifampin is a rifamycin antibiotic that inhibits bacterial DNA-dependent RNA polymerase and is a key component of tuberculosis treatment; it causes orange body fluids and has many drug interactions and hepatotoxicity risk.

Rifampin Toxicity

Adverse pharmacological effects of the first-line rifamycin antibiotic rifampin, including benign orange-red discoloration of body secretions (urine, tears, sweat), drug-induced hepatotoxicity, an immune-mediated flu-like syndrome with intermittent dosing, and potent induction of hepatic cytochrome P450 enzymes (CYP3A4).

Rifamycin

Rifamycin is an antibiotic that inhibits bacterial RNA polymerase; related rifamycin medicines are used for tuberculosis and other infections.

Rifaximin

Rifaximin is a minimally absorbed rifamycin antibiotic used for selected intestinal infections, prevention of recurrent hepatic encephalopathy, and some diarrhoeal syndromes; indication and resistance patterns guide use.

Rift Valley Fever

A mosquito-borne viral disease affecting animals and humans, usually causing fever but sometimes severe eye, brain, or hemorrhagic disease.

Right Atrium

The upper-right chamber of the heart. It receives oxygen-poor blood from the body and passes it through the tricuspid valve into the right ventricle, which sends it to the lungs.

Right Bundle Branch

A group of heart fibers that carries the electrical signal to the right lower chamber so it contracts. If conduction is delayed or blocked, the ECG shows right bundle-branch block; this may be harmless or reflect heart or lung disease.

Right Bundle Branch Block

Delay or interruption of electrical signals through the right bundle branch. It changes the ECG pattern and may occur without symptoms or with heart or lung disease.

Alternate Names:
RBBB

Right Coronary Artery

A blood vessel that branches from the aorta and supplies much of the right side and lower part of the heart. A blockage can cause a heart attack or abnormal heart rhythm.

Right Coronary Artery Occlusion

A blockage of the artery supplying much of the right and lower heart. It can cause a heart attack, slow or abnormal rhythms, low blood pressure, or failure of the right side of the heart.

Right Heart Failure

Failure of the right side of the heart to pump blood effectively to the lungs. It may result from left-sided heart failure, high pressure in the lung arteries, a heart attack, lung clots, heart-muscle disease, or a stiff sac around the heart. It can cause swollen legs, neck veins, an enlarged liver, abdominal fluid, and weight gain.

Right Heart Ventricular Angiography

An imaging test in which contrast dye and X-rays show the right lower heart chamber and how it pumps blood. It is used selectively to assess structure, movement, or blood flow during heart evaluation.

Right Hypochondriac Region

The upper-right area of the abdomen, beneath the lower ribs. It contains much of the liver, the gallbladder, and part of the intestine. Pain there may arise from these organs.

Right Iliac Region

The lower-right area of the abdomen, containing the appendix, beginning of the large intestine, and part of the small intestine. Pain there may occur with appendicitis, bowel disease, urinary problems, or a hernia; location alone does not identify the cause.

Righting Reflex

The righting reflex is an automatic response that restores head and body orientation when balance or position changes.

Right Lower Quadrant

The lower-right quarter of the abdomen, containing the appendix, cecum, portions of the small and large intestines, the right ureter, and, in females, the right ovary and uterine tube.

Right Lower Quadrant Abdominal Pain

Pain in the lower-right part of the abdomen. Appendicitis is one possible cause, but bowel, urinary, reproductive, and other conditions can also cause it.

Right Lymphatic Duct

A short vessel that returns lymph from the right arm, right side of the head and neck, and right upper chest to the bloodstream near the right side of the neck. Damage or blockage can cause swelling in these areas.

Right Sixth Cranial Nerve Palsy

Weakness of the nerve that moves the right eye outward. It can cause double vision, usually worse when looking to the right or at a distance, and may result from diabetes, high pressure in the skull, inflammation, stroke, or other disease.

Right Upper Quadrant

The upper-right quarter of the abdomen, containing the liver, gallbladder, duodenum, and portions of the small and large intestines.

Right Ureterovesical Calculus

A stone lodged at the junction of the right ureter and bladder, causing flank pain, hematuria, and urinary urgency or frequency. May require endoscopic or lithotripsy intervention.

Right Ventricle

The lower-right chamber of the heart. It receives oxygen-poor blood from the right atrium and pumps it through the pulmonary valve into the lung arteries to receive oxygen.

Right Ventricular Assist Device

A mechanical pump that supports blood flow from the right ventricle to the pulmonary circulation in selected patients with severe right-sided heart failure.

Right Ventricular Strain

Increased pressure or workload on the right ventricle. It may be suggested by ECG or imaging findings, but these findings are nonspecific and do not by themselves diagnose pulmonary embolism or another cause.

Rigid And Flexible Sigmoidoscopy

A sigmoidoscopy examines the rectum and lower colon with a flexible or rigid instrument. It can evaluate bleeding, pain, altered bowel habits, inflammation, polyps, or tumors; preparation, reach, comfort, and biopsy capability differ by technique.

Rigidity

Abnormally increased resistance when a relaxed limb is moved by another person. It can occur with Parkinson disease, brain or spinal injury, severe infection, certain medicines, or other movement disorders.

Rigler Sign

A classic abdominal radiographic sign of massive pneumoperitoneum (free intra-abdominal air) on plain supine radiographs, where both the inner (mucosal) and outer (serosal) surfaces of the bowel wall are clearly outlined by gas.

Alternate Names:
Double Wall Sign; Bas-Relief Sign

Rigler Triad

Three imaging findings that strongly suggest gallstone ileus: blockage of the small intestine, air in the bile ducts, and a gallstone in the intestine. Not every person has all three findings.

Rigor

Marked stiffness or rigidity; rigor mortis is postmortem muscle stiffening, while rigor may also mean a severe chill.

Rigor Mortis

Stiffening of the body's muscles after death. It develops as the muscles lose the energy needed to relax and later fades as decomposition advances; its timing is affected by temperature, activity, illness, and the environment.

Rilpivirine

An HIV medicine that blocks an enzyme the virus needs to copy itself. It is taken with other antiretroviral medicines, and missed doses or drug interactions can allow resistance to develop.

Riluzole

A medicine used to treat amyotrophic lateral sclerosis; it can modestly prolong survival but does not reverse the disease.

Rimmed Vacuoles

Small empty-looking spaces with a visible border seen inside muscle cells on biopsy. They indicate that muscle cells are breaking down or recycling parts of themselves and can occur in conditions such as inclusion-body myositis and GNE myopathy. The finding must be interpreted with symptoms and other tests.

Alternate Names:
Autophagic Rimmed Vacuoles

Ring Block

Local anesthetic injected around the base of a finger or toe to numb the entire digit.

Ring Chromosome

A chromosome whose two ends have joined to form a ring, often with loss or disruption of genetic material. It may cause developmental or other health problems, depending on the chromosome and changes involved.

Ringing In The Ear

Alternate name; see *Tinnitus*.

Alternate Names:
Tinnitus; Ringing In The Ears

Ringing In The Ears

Plural form; see *Tinnitus*.

Rings Around Cornea

Visible rings or arcs in the clear front part of the eye or around the colored part. A gray-white ring may be arcus senilis; a gold or green-brown ring may be a Kayser-Fleischer ring caused by copper buildup. The cause depends on the ring's appearance and the person's age.

Ring Vaccination

A public-health strategy in which close contacts and contacts of contacts around an identified case are vaccinated to create a protective ring and limit transmission.

Ringworm

A contagious fungal infection of the skin, scalp, hair, or nails. It commonly causes an itchy, scaly rash with a ring-like edge; scalp infection may cause broken hairs or hair loss. The appearance and complications vary by the affected site.

Alternate Names:
Dermatophytosis

Ringworm Of The Body

A contagious fungal infection of body skin causing an itchy, scaly, ring-shaped rash. It spreads through contact with infected people, animals, or objects and usually responds to antifungal treatment.

Ringworm Of The Foot

Alternate name; see *Athlete's Foot*.

Ringworm Of The Scalp

A fungal infection of the scalp and hair that can cause scaling, broken hairs, and hair loss.

Ringworm (Tinea)

Alternate name; see *Ringworm*.

Rinne and Weber Tests

Complementary bedside tuning fork examinations (typically using a 512 Hz fork) to evaluate auditory hearing loss: Rinne compares air conduction to bone conduction in each ear, while Weber tests lateralization of sound when the vibrating fork is placed on the midline forehead.

Rinnes Test

Alternate spelling; see *Rinne Test*.

Rinne Test

A hearing test that compares sound conducted through the air with sound conducted through bone using a vibrating tuning fork. It can help distinguish conductive hearing loss from sensorineural loss.

RIPE Therapy

A combination of rifampin, isoniazid, pyrazinamide, and ethambutol used in some initial regimens for drug-susceptible tuberculosis. The medicines and treatment duration depend on drug susceptibility, disease site, and the current treatment guideline.

Rippling Muscle Disease

A rare, benign myopathy characterized by mechanically-induced muscle contractions that spread across the muscle as a visible wave (rippling), typically triggered by stretch, percussion, or movement.

Risedronate Sodium

The sodium salt of risedronate, a bisphosphonate used to prevent or treat osteoporosis and other disorders of excessive bone resorption.

Risk

Risk is the probability of an unwanted event or outcome, considered together with its severity and the circumstances that influence it.

Risk Adjustment

Risk adjustment accounts for differences in baseline patient characteristics so outcomes or payments can be compared more fairly across groups.

Risk Factor

A characteristic, exposure, or behavior linked with a higher chance of disease or another outcome. It may be changeable, such as smoking, or unchangeable, such as age or inherited traits.

Risk Management

Finding possible sources of harm, judging how likely and serious they are, and taking steps to reduce them. In healthcare, it includes safe systems, reporting problems, learning from errors, and checking whether safety measures work.

Risk Register

A documented list of identified risks, their likelihood, impact, controls, owners, and review status.

Risks Of Hip And Knee Replacement

Possible problems after joint replacement include infection, blood clots, bleeding, nerve or vessel injury, dislocation, stiffness, loosening, wear, persistent pain, and need for repeat surgery. Risk varies with the operation and the person's health.

Risks Of Tobacco

Tobacco use increases risks of cancer, heart and blood-vessel disease, stroke, lung disease, pregnancy complications, addiction, and harm from second-hand smoke.

Risks Of Underage Drinking

Alcohol use by minors can impair brain development, judgment, learning, safety, and mental health and increases risks of injury, dependence, and unsafe sexual or substance-related behavior.

Risk-Taking

Risk-taking is behavior involving deliberate or inadvertent exposure to possible harm, influenced by perception, reward, development, mental health, and circumstances.

Risky Drinking

Alcohol use that increases the chance of health, safety, work, relationship, or social problems. Risk depends on amount, frequency, pattern, personal health, medicines, pregnancy, age, and circumstances such as driving.

Alternate Names:
Hazardous Drinking; At-Risk Alcohol Consumption

Risperidone

Risperidone is an atypical antipsychotic that blocks dopamine and serotonin receptors and treats schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, and selected severe behavioral symptoms; hyperprolactinaemia, metabolic effects, movement disorders, and sedation may occur.

Ristocetin-Induced Platelet Aggregation

A blood test that checks how platelets clump when exposed to ristocetin, a substance that requires von Willebrand factor and a platelet surface protein. It helps investigate von Willebrand disease and some platelet disorders.

Risus Sardonicus

A fixed, strained grin caused by painful facial-muscle spasms. It is classically associated with tetanus or strychnine poisoning and reflects severe muscle overactivity.

Ritonavir

Ritonavir is an HIV protease inhibitor mainly used at low doses to boost levels of other antiviral medicines by slowing their breakdown.

Ritual

A ritual is a repeated, structured behavior or ceremony; repetitive rituals may also occur as compulsions in obsessive-compulsive disorder.

Rituximab

Rituximab is a monoclonal antibody against CD20 that depletes B cells and is used for B-cell malignancies and selected autoimmune diseases; infusion reactions, infections, hepatitis-B reactivation, and rare PML are important risks.

Rivaroxaban

Rivaroxaban is an oral direct factor Xa inhibitor used to prevent or treat venous thromboembolism and reduce stroke risk in selected atrial fibrillation; bleeding and renal-function-dependent dosing are important considerations.

Rivastigmine

A medicine that increases acetylcholine signaling and may temporarily improve thinking or daily function in Alzheimer disease or Parkinson disease dementia. Common effects include nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, appetite loss, dizziness, and slow heartbeat.

River Blindness

Onchocerciasis, a parasitic infection caused by Onchocerca volvulus and transmitted by blackflies. It can cause severe itching, skin disease, and visual impairment.

RLS

Restless legs syndrome, an urge to move the legs with uncomfortable sensations, especially at night.

Alternate Names:
Restless Legs Syndrome; Willis-Ekbom Disease

RMDs

Abbreviation; see *Repetitive Motion Disorders*.

RNA

Ribonucleic acid, a molecule that helps cells read genetic instructions and make proteins. Some RNA carries messages from DNA, some helps build proteins, and some controls cell activity or forms part of viruses.

RNA Binding

The attachment of a protein or other molecule to RNA, affecting RNA stability, transport, folding, processing, or translation.

RNA Biosynthesis

The cellular production of RNA from a DNA template or, for some viruses, from an RNA template.

RNA Degradation

The enzyme-controlled breakdown of RNA molecules. It controls how long genetic messages last, removes damaged or unnecessary messages, recycles their building blocks, and helps regulate protein production and cell behavior.

RNA Folding

The process by which an RNA strand forms secondary and three-dimensional structures that influence its function.

RNA Helicase

An enzyme that uses energy to separate, reshape, or move RNA structures and RNA-protein complexes. It helps cells copy, process, transport, and destroy RNA and is important for some viruses.

RNA Interference

A gene-silencing process in which small RNAs guide proteins to degrade or block specific messenger RNA molecules.

RNase P

An RNA-protein enzyme complex that processes precursor transfer RNA by removing its extra 5-prime sequence.

RNA Splicing

Removal of introns and joining of exons from a precursor RNA to produce mature messenger RNA or other functional RNA.

RNA Transport

Movement of RNA within a cell or between cells, often mediated by transport proteins and required for translation or signaling.

RNA Virus

A virus whose genetic material is RNA; its replication often involves an RNA-dependent polymerase and may have a high mutation rate.

Road Rage

Aggressive or violent behavior by a driver in response to traffic events. It is not a psychiatric diagnosis and is distinct from intermittent explosive disorder, although impulsive aggression may occur in either context.

Robinow Syndrome

A rare genetic skeletal dysplasia characterized by short stature, short limbs and fingers, and distinctive facial features. Genital underdevelopment, vertebral or rib abnormalities, dental abnormalities, and congenital heart defects may also occur. Autosomal dominant and autosomal recessive forms are recognized, and features vary among affected individuals.

Robot-Assisted Rehabilitation

Robotic devices for repetitive task training. Upper extremity, lower extremity, gait training. Objective measurement, high repetition.

Robotic-Assisted Thoracoscopic Surgery

Chest surgery performed through several small openings using instruments controlled by a surgeon from a console. The camera provides a magnified three-dimensional view and the instruments can move precisely. It may reduce the size of the incisions, but bleeding, infection, air leakage, and conversion to open surgery remain possible.

Alternate Names:
RATS; Robotic Thoracic Surgery; Robotic Lobectomy

Robotic Hysterectomy

Hysterectomy performed through minimally invasive abdominal access using a surgeon-controlled robotic platform. The extent of uterine, cervical, tubal, and ovarian removal depends on the indication and operative plan.

Robotic Surgery

A surgical technique in which a surgeon controls a computer-assisted system that moves a camera and small instruments. It is usually performed through small incisions and may allow precise movements, but the system does not operate independently.

Alternate Names:
Robot-Assisted Surgery; Computer-Assisted Surgery; RAS

Rocker-Bottom Foot

A rigid congenital foot deformity with a convex sole, usually caused by congenital vertical talus. It includes a dorsiflexed midfoot and a hindfoot fixed in equinovalgus; it may occur with neuromuscular or genetic conditions, including trisomy 13 or 18.

Rocky Mountain Spotted Fever

A potentially severe tick-borne infection caused by *Rickettsia rickettsii*. Fever, severe headache, and muscle aches are common; a rash may begin on the wrists and ankles and spread to the trunk, palms, and soles, but it may be absent early or never appear.

Alternate Names:
RMSF

Rod

A specialized retinal photoreceptor cell concentrated in the outer retina that mediates scotopic (dim-light) and peripheral vision. Containing the photopigment rhodopsin (composed of opsin and 11-cis-retinal), rods possess exquisite light sensitivity capable of signaling single photons but do not mediate chromatic discrimination or high visual acuity.

Alternate Names:
Rods; Rod Cell; Rod Photoreceptor

Rodenticide Toxicity

Poisoning whose effects depend on the active ingredient. Anticoagulant products can cause delayed bleeding, bromethalin can cause neurologic injury, cholecalciferol can cause high blood calcium and kidney injury, and metal phosphides can cause shock and organ failure.

Rodent Ulcer

An older name for basal cell carcinoma, a common locally invasive skin cancer.

Rod Photoreceptor

A light-sensitive cell in the retina that supports vision in dim light and the peripheral field. Rods do not provide color vision; their loss can cause night blindness and narrowing of the visual field.

Rods

Plural form; see *Rod*.

Rods And Cones

Two types of light-sensing cells in the retina. Rods help with dim-light and side vision, while cones provide sharp and color vision in brighter light.

Roentgen Rays

Alternate name; see *X-Ray*.

Alternate Names:

Roentgen Radiation; Electromagnetic X-Radiation

Rofecoxib

Rofecoxib is a selective COX-2 anti-inflammatory drug withdrawn in many countries because of increased cardiovascular risk.

Romano-Ward Syndrome

The most common congenital long QT syndrome, inherited in an autosomal dominant pattern without associated neurosensory deafness (due to mutations in cardiac potassium or sodium channel genes *KCNQ1*, *KCNH2*, or *SCN5A*), predisposing to syncope, polymorphous ventricular tachycardia (torsades de pointes), and sudden cardiac death.

Romanus Lesion

An early inflammatory radiographic finding in ankylosing spondylitis characterized by enthesitis with focal erosion and surrounding reactive sclerosis at the anterior superior and inferior corners of vertebral bodies ('shiny corners'), preceding syndesmophyte formation.

Alternate Names:
Shiny Corner Sign; Spondylitis Anterior Enthesitis

Rombergism

Unsteadiness or falling when standing with feet together and eyes closed, indicating impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

Romberg Sign

Loss of balance when standing with the feet together and the eyes closed, suggesting impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

Romberg's Sign

Increased unsteadiness when a person stands with the feet together and closes the eyes, suggesting impaired proprioception or vestibular function.

Romberg Test

A balance test in which a person stands with the feet together, first with the eyes open and then closed. Marked worsening when the eyes close suggests impaired proprioceptive or vestibular input; cerebellar ataxia usually affects balance even with the eyes open.

Romidepsin

A histone deacetylase inhibitor used for selected T-cell lymphomas; it can cause cytopenias, infection risk, and ECG-related effects.

Romiplostim

A thrombopoietin-receptor agonist that stimulates platelet production and is used mainly for chronic immune thrombocytopenia.

Rongeur

A strong, jawed surgical instrument used to bite and remove small pieces of bone or other hard tissue.

Ronnel

Ronnel is an organophosphate insecticide that can inhibit acetylcholinesterase and cause cholinergic toxicity after exposure.

Root Canal

The channel inside a tooth root containing the pulp and its nerves and blood vessels.

Root Canal Therapy

Dental treatment in which infected or inflamed pulp is removed from a tooth, the canal is cleaned and sealed, and the tooth is restored.

Root Canal Treatment

Alternate term; see *Root Canal Therapy*.

Root Caries

Tooth decay affecting exposed root surfaces after gum recession or loss of protective covering. It is more common with aging, dry mouth, or limited cleaning and may be slowed with fluoride and dental care.

Root Filling

Dental treatment sealing a cleaned tooth root canal to prevent bacteria entering again and causing rein-

fection.

Root Fracture

A crack or break in the root of a tooth. A horizontal fracture may sometimes be stabilized and monitored, while a vertical fracture often allows bacteria to enter and may require removal of the tooth. Treatment depends on the fracture's location and extent.

Rooting Reflex

An infant reflex in which touching the cheek or corner of the mouth causes the infant to turn toward the touch and open the mouth. It supports feeding and usually fades during the first several months as voluntary control develops.

Ropinirole

A medicine that stimulates dopamine receptors and is used for Parkinson disease and restless legs syndrome. It may cause nausea, dizziness, sleepiness, low blood pressure, hallucinations, swelling, or impulse-control problems such as gambling.

Ropivacaine

A long-acting local anesthetic used for regional nerve blocks and epidural anesthesia; excessive blood levels can cause neurologic or cardiac toxicity.

Ropivacaine Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride salt of ropivacaine, a long-acting local anesthetic used for regional and epidural anesthesia.

Rorschach Test

A projective psychological test using inkblots; its diagnostic validity is limited and interpretation requires specialist training.

Rosacea

A chronic inflammatory skin disorder that mainly affects the central face, causing persistent or recurrent redness, flushing, visible small blood vessels, and sometimes papules or pustules. Burning, eye inflammation, or thickening of the skin, especially the nose (rhinophyma), may also occur. It is distinct from acne and is not contagious.

Rosai-Dorfman Disease

A rare histiocytic disorder, often involving enlarged lymph nodes in the neck but sometimes affecting skin or other organs. Tissue typically shows large histiocytes containing intact blood cells or immune cells (emperipolesis); severity ranges from self-limited disease to serious multisystem involvement.

Alternate Names:
Sinus Histiocytosis with Massive Lymphadenopathy; SHML

Rose Bengal

Rose bengal is a dye used in eye-surface testing and laboratory or diagnostic procedures; it highlights damaged or poorly protected conjunctival cells.

Roseola

A common childhood viral illness, usually caused by human herpesvirus 6 and sometimes HHV-7. Several days of high fever are followed by a pink-red rash, often on the trunk, as the fever resolves; febrile seizures may occur.

Alternate Names:
Exanthema Subitum; Sixth Disease

Roseola Infantum

Alternate name; see *Roseola*.

Roseolovirus

A genus of herpesviruses that includes human herpesvirus 6 and 7, commonly associated with roseola and sometimes serious disease after reactivation.

Rosiglitazone

A medicine for type 2 diabetes that helps the body respond better to insulin and lower blood sugar. It can cause weight gain, swelling, fractures, or worsening heart failure and is used selectively.

Rosiglitazone Maleate

The maleate salt of rosiglitazone, a thiazolidinedione

that improves insulin sensitivity in type 2 diabetes but may cause weight gain, edema, fractures, and heart-failure worsening.

Ross Procedure

An operation for severe aortic-valve disease, especially in some children and young adults. The patient's own pulmonary valve is moved to the aortic position, and a donor valve or tube replaces it. The moved valve can grow in children and usually avoids lifelong blood-thinning medicine, but either valve may later narrow or leak.

Alternate Names:
Pulmonary Autograft Procedure; Ross Operation

Ross River Virus

A mosquito-borne alphavirus that causes Ross River fever, with fever, rash, and often prolonged joint pain or swelling.

Rostral

Positioned toward the nose or front of the head. In descriptions of the brain, it usually means toward the forehead or front rather than toward the back of the head.

Rosuvastatin Calcium

Rosuvastatin calcium is a statin medicine that lowers LDL cholesterol and reduces the risk of cardiovascular events.

Rotation

Movement around an axis; in anatomy it describes turning a body part inward, outward, or around its longitudinal axis.

Rotator Cuff

The group of four shoulder muscles and tendons that stabilize the glenohumeral joint and rotate the arm.

Alternate Names:
Musculotendinous Cuff; SITS Muscles

Rotator Cuff Arthropathy

Shoulder-joint damage that develops after long-standing, irreparable tears of the rotator-cuff tendons. It can cause pain, weakness, grinding, and inability to raise the arm; severe cases may need specialized shoulder replacement.

Rotator Cuff Exercises

Rotator cuff exercises strengthen and stretch shoulder muscles and are selected according to the injury, pain, range of motion, and rehabilitation plan.

Rotator Cuff Injury

Damage to one or more shoulder tendons or muscles that stabilize and move the arm. It may cause pain, weakness, night discomfort, or limited movement after overuse, aging, or sudden injury.

Rotator Cuff Problems

Rotator cuff problems include tendinopathy, bursitis, and tears that cause shoulder pain, weakness, painful motion, and difficulty with overhead activity.

Rotator Cuff Repair

Surgery to reattach a torn shoulder tendon to the upper-arm bone, usually with small instruments or an open approach. Recovery requires structured rehabilitation and may take months; stiffness, weakness, recurrent tearing, or infection can occur.

Rotator Cuff Tear

A partial or complete tear of one or more tendons stabilizing the shoulder, causing pain, weakness, and difficulty raising or rotating the arm.

Rotator Cuff Tendinitis

Painful irritation of one or more rotator-cuff tendons, usually related to repeated overhead use or age-related tendon changes. The term rotator cuff tendinopathy is also used.

Rotavirus

A genus of double-stranded RNA viruses in the *Reoviridae* family characterized by a distinctive wheel-like triple-layered icosahedral capsid, representing the leading global cause of severe dehydrating gastroenteritis in infants and young children under age

five. The virus infects and destroys mature enterocytes of the villous tips of the small intestine and produces the enterotoxin NSP4, inducing secretory osmotic diarrhea, projectile vomiting, and rapid dehydration. Universal infant rotavirus vaccination (oral live-attenuated vaccines) has dramatically diminished worldwide hospitalizations and pediatric mortality.

Alternate Names:
Rotaviruses; Human Rotavirus

Rotavirus Antigen Test

A rotavirus antigen test detects rotavirus proteins in stool and can help diagnose viral gastroenteritis, especially in infants and young children.

Rotaviruses

Plural form; see *Rotavirus*.

Rotavirus Infection

A highly contagious viral gastroenteritis causing vomiting and watery diarrhea, especially in infants and young children; vaccination prevents most severe disease.

Rotavirus Vaccine

A live-attenuated oral viral vaccine administered to young infants in a 2- or 3-dose series to prevent severe dehydrating gastroenteritis and diarrhea caused by rotavirus infection, carrying a slight, transient risk of intussusception.

Rotenone

Rotenone is a naturally occurring pesticide that inhibits mitochondrial complex I and can be toxic to people and animals after exposure.

Rothmund-Thomson Syndrome

A rare inherited condition that causes a mottled, red, and thin skin rash beginning in infancy, short stature, sparse hair, skeletal or dental problems, and sometimes cataracts. It also increases the risk of certain cancers.

Roth Spots

Small areas of bleeding in the retina with pale centers, seen during an eye examination. They may occur with infection of the heart valves, severe anemia, leukemia, diabetes, or other illnesses and are not specific to one diagnosis.

Roth's Spots

Small retinal haemorrhages with pale centres, associated with conditions such as infective endocarditis, severe anaemia, leukaemia, and diabetes.

Rotor Syndrome

A rare inherited condition in which the liver does not take up and store bilirubin normally. It causes lifelong, usually mild yellowing of the skin or eyes but does not usually damage the liver. It is caused by changes in genes that control how liver cells move bilirubin.

Alternate Names:
Rotor's Syndrome; Familial Conjugated Hyperbilirubinemia

Rotterdam Criteria

A commonly used approach for diagnosing polycystic ovary syndrome in adults. After other causes are excluded, diagnosis generally requires at least two of: irregular or absent ovulation, signs or blood-test evidence of high androgen levels, or polycystic-appearing ovaries on ultrasound. Ultrasound alone does not establish the diagnosis.

Rotter Nodes

Small interpectoral lymph nodes situated between the pectoralis major and pectoralis minor muscles that provide an alternate pathway for breast lymphatic drainage directly to Level II and III axillary lymph nodes.

Alternate Names:
Interpectoral Lymph Nodes; Rotter's Nodes

Rouleau

A stack or column of red blood cells, commonly seen in blood with increased plasma proteins.

Rouleaux

A pattern where red blood cells stack like coins, often because blood plasma contains extra proteins.

Rouleaux Formation

Linear, coin-like stacks or rolls of red blood cells visualized on a peripheral blood smear, occurring when elevated plasma concentrations of asymmetric acute-phase proteins (fibrinogen or monoclonal immunoglobulins) neutralize the normal negative repulsive zeta potential of erythrocytes, characteristically seen in multiple myeloma and severe inflammatory states.

Round

Circular or approximately spherical; in anatomy or pathology, describing the shape of a structure.

Round Back

Alternate name; see *Kyphosis*.

Round Ligament

A round ligament is a cord-like supporting structure, including the uterine ligaments that pass toward the groin and help maintain uterine position.

Round Ligament of the Uterus

A fibrous and muscular cord originating from the superior-lateral aspect of the uterine cornu anterior to the fallopian tube, traversing through the inguinal canal to terminate in the subcutaneous tissue of the labium majus, functioning to hold the uterus in an anteverted and anteflexed position.

Round Ligament Pain

Sharp or aching pain in the lower abdomen or groin caused by stretching of the round ligaments as the uterus enlarges during pregnancy. Persistent or severe pain, especially with bleeding, can have causes other than ligament stretching.

Round Pneumonia

A lung infection that appears as a rounded shadow on a chest X-ray rather than the usual patchy pattern. It occurs especially in children and can resemble a tumor; imaging findings may change as the infection resolves.

Roundworm

Any cylindrical, unsegmented parasitic nematode, most prominently referring to *Ascaris lumbricoides*, the largest intestinal nematode infecting humans. Acquired through the fecal-oral ingestion of embryonated eggs from contaminated soil, larvae penetrate the intestinal mucosa, migrate hematogenously through the lungs (producing Löffler syndrome with eosinophilia), are swallowed, and mature into adult worms in the jejunum. Heavy worm burdens cause intestinal obstruction, malnutrition, or biliary tract migration; treatment entails anthelmintics (albendazole, mebendazole, or ivermectin).

Alternate Names:
Roundworms; Nematode; Ascariasis

Roundworms

Plural form; see *Roundworm*.

Roussy-Levy Syndrome

An autosomal dominant hereditary motor and sensory neuropathy (a phenotypic variant of Charcot-Marie-Tooth disease type 1A) characterized by early-onset sensory ataxia, prominent postural hand tremor, distal muscle weakness and wasting, pes cavus, and absent deep tendon reflexes.

Alternate Names:
Hereditary Areflexic Dystasia; CMT-Tremor Variant

Route Of Administration

The way a medicine enters the body, such as by mouth, under the tongue, injection, inhalation, skin application, or through a vein. The route affects how quickly and how much of the medicine reaches the bloodstream.

Roux-en-Y Gastric Bypass

Weight-loss surgery that creates a small stomach pouch and connects it to the small intestine, bypassing most of the stomach and the first part of the intestine. It reduces food intake and changes nutrient absorption.

Alternate Names:
RYGB

Roux Stasis Syndrome

Delayed movement of food through the surgically created Roux limb after Roux-en-Y gastric or other surgery. It can cause fullness after eating, nausea, vomiting, and abdominal discomfort.

Alternate Names:
Roux-en-Y Stasis Syndrome; Chronic Roux Limb Stasis

Rovsing Sign

Pain in the lower right abdomen that occurs when the lower left abdomen is pressed. This examination finding can support suspicion of appendicitis but is not diagnostic by itself.

Roxithromycin

A macrolide antibiotic used in some countries for selected bacterial infections. It stops bacteria making proteins, but resistance, medicine interactions, stomach upset, liver problems, and heart-rhythm changes can occur.

RPR Test

A blood test used to screen for syphilis and monitor treatment. It detects antibodies to lipoidal antigens that may occur with syphilis or other conditions; reactive results are interpreted with a treponemal test and clinical findings.

RS3PE Syndrome

Remitting seronegative symmetrical synovitis with pitting edema, an inflammatory syndrome causing sudden swelling of the hands or feet, joint pain, and stiffness, usually in older adults. It may occur with another rheumatic disease, infection, or cancer.

Alternate Names:
Remitting Seronegative Symmetrical Synovitis with Pitting Edema

RSI

Repetitive strain injury, a group of pain and dysfunction syndromes associated with repeated movement or sustained posture.

RSV

A common respiratory virus that can cause mild cold symptoms or serious bronchiolitis and pneumonia, especially in infants and older adults.

RSV Antibody Test

An RSV antibody test detects antibodies to respiratory syncytial virus and may help assess past exposure or immune response, but is not usually the main test for acute infection.

RSV Infection

Alternate name; see *Respiratory Syncytial Virus Infection*.

RT-PCR

A laboratory test that converts RNA into DNA and then makes many copies of a selected genetic sequence so it can be detected. It can identify RNA viruses and measure selected genes in clinical samples.

Rubber

Rubber is an elastic material used in gloves, devices, and equipment; natural-rubber latex can cause irritant or allergic reactions.

Rubber Band Ligation

A procedure for selected internal hemorrhoids in which a small elastic band is placed around the base of the hemorrhoidal tissue above the pain-sensitive area of the anal canal. The band cuts off its blood supply, causing the tissue to shrink and separate over several days; bleeding, pain, or recurrence can occur.

Alternate Names:
Hemorrhoidal Banding; RBL; Band Ligation of Hemorrhoids; Elastic Band Ligation

Rubber Cement Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing or inhaling rubber cement, which contains volatile solvents. It may cause dizziness, drowsiness, confusion, breathing problems,

or chemical pneumonitis if it enters the lungs.

Rubber Dams

Sheets used in dentistry to isolate teeth from saliva and the rest of the mouth during procedures.

Rubella

A contagious viral infection that is often mild or asymptomatic. It may cause a fine maculopapular rash, low-grade fever, and enlarged lymph nodes behind the ears, at the back of the head, or in the neck. Infection during pregnancy can cause miscarriage or congenital rubella syndrome, including hearing, eye, heart, or neurologic abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
Three-Day Measles

Rubella Virus

An RNA virus in the genus *Rubivirus* that causes rubella. Infection during pregnancy can cross the placenta and cause congenital rubella syndrome.

Rubeola

See *Measles*.

Rubeosis Iridis

Growth of abnormal new blood vessels on the colored part of the eye. It usually results from poor blood flow in the retina, often caused by diabetes or a blocked retinal vein, and can lead to painful glaucoma and vision loss.

Rubidium

A chemical element whose radioactive isotopes can be used in medical imaging; nonmedical rubidium compounds can affect potassium-related physiology.

Rubin Maneuver

An emergency childbirth technique for shoulder dystocia, when a baby's shoulder is stuck behind the birthing person's pelvic bone. A clinician applies pressure and rotates the baby's shoulder to reduce its width and help complete delivery safely.

Rubinstein-Taybi Syndrome

A genetic developmental disorder associated with characteristic facial features, short stature, broad thumbs and toes, and intellectual disability. It is commonly caused by pathogenic variants in CREBBP or EP300.

Rubivirus

A genus of viruses that includes rubella virus, which causes rubella and congenital rubella syndrome.

Rubredoxins

Small proteins containing iron that help move electrons in some bacteria and other organisms. They take part in chemical reactions that release energy and protect cells from harmful oxygen-related chemicals.

Rubricyte Count

A measurement of rubricytes, an older name for immature red blood cells, in blood or bone marrow. It may help assess how actively the marrow is making red cells, but modern tests usually report reticulocytes or other marrow findings.

Rule Of Nines

A quick method for estimating the percentage of body surface burned by assigning simple proportions to body regions. The estimate helps guide fluids and emergency care, but children and unusual body shapes require more accurate methods.

Rule Out

Rule out means evaluate a possibility and determine whether it is present; it does not mean the condition has already been excluded.

Rumination

Repeated regurgitation and rechewing of food after eating, without the usual vomiting process. It is a behavior or symptom that may occur in rumination disorder or with other gastrointestinal, developmental, or behavioral conditions.

Rumination Disorder

A feeding or eating disorder involving repeated, usually effortless return of recently eaten food to the mouth, followed by rechewing, reswallowing, or spitting. It differs from ordinary vomiting and causes clinically significant distress, impairment, or nutritional or medical consequences.

Rumination Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Rumination Disorder*.

Ruminococcus Gnavus

An intestinal bacterium involved in mucin and carbohydrate metabolism and studied in relation to gut inflammation.

Rumpel-Leede Sign

Small pinpoint bleeding spots that appear below a blood-pressure cuff after it has briefly been inflated. They reflect capillary bleeding under pressure and can occur with thrombocytopenia, platelet dysfunction, or other causes; the finding is nonspecific.

Rumpel-Leede Test

A tourniquet test historically used to assess capillary fragility and as an adjunct in dengue evaluation. A blood-pressure cuff is held midway between systolic and diastolic pressure for five minutes, then petechiae are counted in a defined area; dengue protocols commonly use at least 10 petechiae per square inch as a positive result, though criteria vary.

Alternate Names:
Capillary Fragility Test; Tourniquet Test

Runner's Knee

Alternate name; see *Patellofemoral Pain Syndrome*.

Runny Nose

Excess fluid or mucus draining from the nose, commonly caused by infection, allergy, irritants, or sinus disease.

Rupture

A tear or complete break in an organ, vessel, muscle, or other tissue, often causing bleeding or loss of function.

Ruptured Abdominal Aortic Aneurysm

A burst in a weakened section of the main artery in the abdomen, causing severe internal bleeding. Sudden abdominal or back pain, fainting, sweating, or collapse may occur.

Ruptured Disk

An older, imprecise term for a herniated intervertebral disk, in which disk material extends beyond its usual boundary and may irritate or compress nearby nerves.

Alternate Names:
Herniated Disc; Slipped Disc; Herniated Nucleus Pulposus

Ruptured Eardrum

A ruptured eardrum is a tear in the tympanic membrane caused by infection, pressure, trauma, or foreign objects and may cause pain, drainage, hearing loss, or dizziness.

Ruptured Perforated Eardrum

See *Ruptured Eardrum*.

Russell-Silver Syndrome

A condition present from birth that causes poor growth before and after birth, a relatively large head, feeding difficulty, uneven growth of the limbs or body, and characteristic facial features. It is usually related to changes in gene regulation.

Russell Viper Venom Time

A blood-clotting test used as part of testing for lupus anticoagulants. The venom activates clotting in the test tube; a prolonged result that shortens when extra phospholipid is added supports the presence of a lupus anticoagulant but does not establish the diagnosis by itself.

Alternate Names:
dRVVT

Rx

A common abbreviation for prescription or pre-

scribed treatment. It comes from the Latin word meaning “take” and is used on medication orders and in medical writing.

Ryle’s Tube

An eponym for a flexible nasogastric tube passed through the nose, pharynx, and esophagus into the stomach. Its tip remains in the stomach, where it can drain or sample gastric contents or deliver fluids, nutrition, or medicines.

S

S3 Gallop Pathology

An extra heart sound heard just after the normal second heart sound as the lower chambers fill rapidly. It can be normal in children and pregnancy but may suggest excess fluid or heart failure in an older adult.

S4 Gallop Pathology

An extra heart sound heard just before the normal first heart sound when an upper chamber pushes blood into a stiff lower chamber. It may occur with long-standing high blood pressure, a narrowed aortic valve, or thickened heart muscle.

SAA

Usually an abbreviation for serum amyloid A, a blood protein that rises during inflammation. Persistently high levels can contribute to abnormal protein deposits in organs during some long-lasting inflammatory diseases.

Sabin Vaccine

The oral polio vaccine containing live attenuated poliovirus strains. It produces strong intestinal immunity but, rarely, vaccine-derived poliovirus can occur, so vaccine policy depends on local public-health guidance.

Sabre Tibia

Forward bowing and thickening of the shinbone, classically associated with congenital syphilis or Paget disease of bone.

Alternate Names:
Saber Shin

Saccade

A quick, coordinated eye movement that shifts the eyes from one target to another. Abnormal saccades can occur with disorders affecting the eye muscles, balance system, or brain and nerves.

Saccular Aneurysm

A rounded pouch bulging from one side of an artery because that part of the vessel wall is weak. It may enlarge, form clots, or burst; risk depends on its location, size, shape, and growth.

Saccule

A small, fluid-filled part of the inner ear that senses gravity and straight-line movement, especially up-and-down movement. It helps the brain maintain balance and know the head's position.

Sachet Poisoning

Illness caused by swallowing, inhaling, or getting the contents of a sachet on the skin or in the eyes. Effects depend on the substance and amount; some sachets contain medicines or dangerous chemicals.

Sacral

Sacral means relating to the sacrum, the triangular bone at the base of the spine that connects with the pelvis.

Sacral Agenesis

Partial or complete absence or underdevelopment of the sacrum. It can occur alone or as one feature of caudal regression syndrome, which may also affect the lower spine, legs, urinary tract, and bowel. Maternal diabetes is a risk factor.

Sacral Dimple

A small indentation in the skin over the lower spine that is present at birth. Most are harmless, but a deep, large, high, hairy, discolored, or draining dimple may need imaging for an underlying spinal abnormality.

Sacral Fistula

An abnormal channel near the lower spine that connects the skin with deeper tissue or another body space. It may cause persistent drainage, pain, repeated infection, or a skin opening and can result from birth differences, injury, or pilonidal disease.

Sacral Nerves

The five pairs of spinal nerves associated with the sacral segments. They supply parts of the pelvis, pelvic floor, bladder, bowel, and lower limbs.

Sacral Nerve Stimulation

An implanted treatment that sends electrical pulses to sacral nerves to improve bladder control in selected people with urinary urgency, incontinence, or retention, and bowel control in some people with fecal incontinence.

Sacral Nerve Stimulator

An implanted device that sends mild electrical signals to nerves near the lower spine to improve bladder or bowel control in selected people. It may help incontinence or some emptying problems when other treatments have not worked.

Sacral Plexus

A network of spinal nerves in the pelvis that supplies the lower limbs, pelvis, and parts of the bladder, bowel, and reproductive organs.

Sacral Region

The lower back and posterior pelvic region overlying the sacrum, a fused triangular bone that connects the lumbar spine with the pelvis.

Sacral Vertebra

One of the fused vertebrae forming the sacrum, which supports the spine, joins the pelvic bones, and transmits trunk weight to the lower limbs.

Sacral Vertebrae

Five spinal bones that fuse to form the sacrum at the back of the pelvis. They transfer weight from the spine to the hips and contain openings through which sacral nerves pass.

Sacrococcygeal

Sacrococcygeal means relating to the sacrum and coccyx at the lower end of the vertebral column.

Sacrococcygeal Chordoma

A malignant tumor arising from remnants of the embryonic notochord at the base of the spine. It may cause tailbone pain, a mass, bowel or bladder symptoms, or nerve problems and is assessed with imaging and biopsy.

Sacrococcygeal Teratoma

A tumor present from birth at the base of the spine and made of several tissue types. It may grow outside or inside the pelvis; a large fetal tumor can strain the heart and increase amniotic fluid.

Sacrocolpopexy

An operation that supports the vaginal apex by attaching it, usually with mesh, to the longitudinal ligament or sacrum near the sacral promontory. When the uterus is retained and supported, the procedure is generally called sacrohysteropexy. It may be performed through open or minimally invasive surgery; bleeding, infection, mesh problems, bowel or bladder injury, and recurrent prolapse are possible.

Sacroiliac Joint

The joint connecting the triangular sacrum at the base of the spine to each hip bone. It transfers weight between the spine and legs and may become painful or inflamed after injury, pregnancy, arthritis, or infection.

Sacroiliac Joint Dysfunction

A broad term for pain or impaired movement attributed to one or both joints connecting the lower spine to the pelvis. Examination is needed because hip, spine, and other conditions can cause similar pain; see also *Sacroiliac Joint Pain*.

Sacroiliac Joint Injury

Sprain, strain, or traumatic disruption of the ligaments and tissues supporting the sacroiliac joint. It can cause localized low-back or buttock pain that worsens with transfers, stairs, prolonged standing, or asymmetric loading.

Sacroiliac Joint Pain

Sacroiliac-joint pain arises near the junction of the lower spine and pelvis and may follow injury, pregnancy, arthritis, leg-length or gait changes, or inflammation. Pain can radiate to the buttock or thigh; examination distinguishes it from hip or spine disease.

Sacroiliitis

Inflammation of one or both joints connecting the lower spine to the pelvis. It can cause pain in the lower back, buttock, or back of the thigh and may result from inflammatory arthritis, infection, injury, or wear.

Sacrospinous Ligament Fixation

An operation through the vagina that attaches the top of the vagina or cervix to a strong pelvic ligament to treat prolapse. It avoids an abdominal incision but may cause buttock pain, bleeding, infection, nerve injury, or recurrent prolapse.

Alternate Names:
Sacrospinous Colpopexy; Sacrospinous Suspension

Sacrum

A large triangular bone at the back of the pelvis formed by five fused spinal bones. It connects the spine to the hip bones, transfers body weight to the legs, and contains openings for nerves supplying the pelvis and lower limbs.

SAD

An abbreviation for seasonal affective disorder, a recurring pattern of depression or mood change linked to a particular season, often winter and reduced daylight. Treatment may include therapy, medicines, or supervised light therapy.

Alternate Names:
Seasonal Depression; Winter Depression

Saddle Anesthesia

Reduced or absent feeling in the area that would touch a saddle, including the inner thighs, buttocks, genitals, and area around the anus. It can indicate compression of nerves at the bottom of the spine, such as in cauda equina syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Perineal Sensory Loss; Saddle Sensory Loss

Saddle Joint

A joint in which each bone has one rounded and one hollow surface, fitting together like a saddle. It allows movement in two main directions, as at the base of the thumb.

Saddle Nose Deformity

A physical collapse and depression of the cartilaginous nasal dorsum resulting from destruction or ischemic necrosis of the nasal septal cartilage, seen in granulomatosis with polyangiitis (GPA), relapsing polychondritis, congenital syphilis, chronic intranasal cocaine use, and nasal trauma.

Alternate Names:
Pug Nose; Depressed Nasal Dorsum

Saddle Pulmonary Embolism

A blood clot lodged where the main pulmonary artery divides toward both lungs. Its central location does not by itself determine severity; effects depend on how much blood flow is blocked and the person's heart and lung response. Symptoms can include sudden breathlessness, chest pain, fainting, or low blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Saddle Embolus; Bifurcation Pulmonary Embolism

S-Adenosylmethionine

A substance made naturally in the body that helps chemical reactions involving cell membranes, genetic material, and brain chemicals. It is also sold as a supplement, but its benefits and interactions vary by condition.

Sadism

Sexual arousal or gratification from inflicting pain, humiliation, or suffering; clinical significance depends on distress, impairment, or nonconsent.

Sad Mood

Sad mood is a feeling of unhappiness or low mood that may be a normal response or a symptom of depression, grief, illness, or another condition.

SAD (Seasonal Affective Disorder)

Alternate name; see *Seasonal Affective Disorder*.

Safe Sex

Sexual practices that reduce the risk of sexually transmitted infections and unintended pregnancy, including condoms or other barriers, testing, vaccination, and informed consent.

Safety Of Drugs

The process of balancing a medicine's expected benefits against side effects, interactions, and reasons it may be unsafe. Safe use includes checking the person, dose, allergies, other medicines, monitoring needs, and instructions.

Safety Plan

A collaboratively written, practical plan for responding to escalating suicidal thoughts or emotional crisis. It identifies warning signs, internal coping strategies, supportive contacts, professional resources, and methods to restrict access to lethal means.

Safety Study

A safety study evaluates whether a medicine, device, procedure, or treatment causes harmful effects and identifies risks before or during clinical use.

Saffron

Saffron is a spice made from the dried stigmas of Crocus sativus. It is used in food and studied as a possible supplement, but it is not a substitute for proven medical treatment.

Safrole

Safrole is a natural aromatic compound found in some plants and oils; high or prolonged exposure is toxic and has carcinogenic concern.

Sagittal

Oriented in a vertical direction that divides the body or a structure into right and left parts. A midsagittal plane divides the parts equally; a parasagittal plane does not.

Sagittal Axis

An imaginary line running from front to back through the body or a body part. Side-to-side movements, such as moving a limb away from or toward the body, occur around this axis.

Sagittal Plane

An imaginary vertical plane dividing the body or an organ into right and left portions. A midsagittal plane divides them equally; a parasagittal plane divides them unequally.

Sagittal Sinus Thrombosis

A blood clot in the superior sagittal sinus, a large vein channel that drains blood from the brain. It may cause headache, seizures, vision problems, weakness, or confusion; diagnosis usually requires brain imaging of the veins.

Alternate Names:
Superior Sagittal Sinus Thrombosis

Salaam Attacks

Brief repeated spasms in an infant, often involving sudden bending of the body, arm movements, or head drops. These are epileptic spasms; the underlying epilepsy can affect development.

Salbutamol

A short-acting inhaled bronchodilator that relaxes airway muscles to relieve wheezing and breathlessness, especially in asthma. It may cause tremor, a fast heartbeat, or palpitations; it does not treat the underlying airway inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Albuterol

Salicylate

A group of chemicals that includes aspirin and can reduce pain, fever, or inflammation. Excessive amounts may cause poisoning with vomiting, ringing ears, fast breathing, confusion, dehydration, or dangerous blood chemistry changes.

Salicylate Toxicity

Poisoning caused by too much aspirin or another salicylate. It may cause vomiting, ringing in the ears, fever, sweating, fast or deep breathing, dehydration, confusion, seizures, or coma.

Salicylic Acid

A medicine applied to the skin to soften and remove excess surface skin. It is used for acne, psoriasis, warts, corns, and similar thickened or blocked skin; irritation is common and large exposures can be toxic.

Saline

A sterile solution of sodium chloride in water. Different concentrations are used for intravenous fluids, wound or eye irrigation, inhalation, laboratory work, or dilution of medicines.

Saline Infusion Sonohysterography

An ultrasound test in which sterile salt water is placed inside the uterus to outline its cavity. It can show polyps, fibroids, scar tissue, or an unusually shaped cavity and may cause temporary cramping or light bleeding.

Saline Nasal Washes

Rinsing the nasal passages with sterile, distilled, or appropriately treated saline to loosen mucus and reduce nasal irritants; unsafe water can cause serious infection.

Saliva

Fluid made by the salivary glands that moistens food, begins digestion, protects the mouth and teeth, and helps swallowing and taste. Too little saliva can cause dry mouth, mouth soreness, and tooth decay.

Salivary Duct Stones

Calcified deposits obstructing a salivary duct, most often the submandibular duct, causing recurrent painful swelling of a gland during meals and sometimes infection.

Salivary Gland

Any of the exocrine glands that produce, modify, and secrete saliva into the oral cavity to facilitate mastication, enzymatic carbohydrate digestion (via salivary amylase and lingual lipase), mucosal lubrication, antimicrobial defense (via lysozyme, lactoferrin, and secretory IgA), and taste sensation. Anatomically divided into three paired major salivary glands (the parotid, submandibular, and sublingual glands) and hundreds of microscopic minor salivary glands distributed throughout the submucosa of the lips, palate, buccal mucosa, and tongue. Pathologies include sialolithiasis, acute sialadenitis, autoimmune destruction (Sjögren syndrome), and benign or malignant neoplasms.

Alternate Names:
Salivary Glands

Salivary Gland Biopsy

Removal of salivary-gland tissue or a needle sample for microscopic examination of suspected autoimmune disease, inflammation, infection, or neoplasm.

Salivary Gland Cancer

Cancer arising in a salivary gland, most often the parotid near the ear. It may cause a persistent lump, pain, numbness, dry mouth, or facial weakness; imaging and biopsy identify the type and guide treatment.

Salivary Gland Infection

An acute or chronic inflammation and infection of a salivary gland (sialadenitis), most frequently involving the parotid or submandibular glands. Typically bacterial in etiology (predominantly *Staphylococcus aureus* or anaerobic streptococci) precipitated by ductal obstruction (sialolithiasis) or dehydration with reduced salivary flow, or viral (classically mumps virus paramyxovirus parotitis). Presents with painful, erythematous glandular enlargement, warmth, purulent ductal discharge (expressible at Stensen or Wharton duct orifice), fever, and trismus; management entails hydration, sialagogues, warm compresses, and systemic antistaphylococcal antibiotics.

Alternate Names:
Salivary Gland Infections; Sialadenitis; Sialoadenitis

Salivary Gland Infections

Plural form; see *Salivary Gland Infection*.

Salivary Gland Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in a salivary gland that may be noncancerous or cancerous. It can cause a lump, pain, facial weakness, dry mouth, or swallowing problems and may require imaging and biopsy.

Salivary Glands

Plural form; see *Salivary Gland*.

Salivary Gland Scintigraphy

An imaging test that measures salivary-gland function after a small radioactive tracer is given. It may help assess dryness from Sjögren syndrome, blocked ducts, inflammation, radiation injury, or other gland problems.

Salivary Gland Stones

Stones formed from minerals in a saliva-making gland or the tube that carries saliva into the mouth. They can block saliva and cause swelling or pain, especially during meals. The medical term is sialolithiasis.

Salivary Stones

Alternate name; see *Sialolithiasis*.

Salivary Gland Tumors

Tumors arising in the salivary glands. Many are benign, especially in the parotid gland; pleomorphic adenoma is a common benign type. Malignant types include mucoepidermoid, adenoid cystic, and acinic cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Salivary Neoplasms

Salivation

Production and release of saliva by the salivary glands. Saliva moistens food, begins digestion, protects teeth, and helps swallowing; excessive or reduced salivation can have many causes.

Salk Vaccine

The inactivated poliovirus vaccine, given by injection to protect against poliomyelitis. It contains killed virus and cannot cause polio; it differs from the older oral live-attenuated vaccine.

Salmonella

A group of bacteria that can cause intestinal infection or enteric fever. Most infections spread through contaminated food or water, or contact with infected animals or people.

Salmonella Choleraesuis

A Salmonella serotype adapted to pigs that can cause severe, invasive infection in humans, including bloodstream infection and pneumonia.

Salmonella Enterica

A major Salmonella species causing human disease. It can produce diarrhea and fever, enteric fever, or bloodstream infection after contaminated food, water, animals, or infected people spread the bacteria.

Salmonella Enterocolitis

Salmonella enterocolitis is intestinal infection causing diarrhea, fever, abdominal cramps, and sometimes bacteremia after contaminated food, water,

or animal exposure.

Salmonella Food Poisoning

Alternate name; see *Salmonellosis*.

Salmonella Infection

A bacterial infection caused by non-typhoidal or typhoidal serovars of the gram-negative bacillus *Salmonella enterica*. Non-typhoidal salmonellosis (commonly *S. enterica* serovars Typhimurium and Enteritidis) is acquired via contaminated poultry, eggs, dairy, or reptiles, causing acute inflammatory enterocolitis with watery or bloody diarrhea, cramping, and fever. In contrast, typhoidal strains (*S. enterica* serovars Typhi and Paratyphi) cause typhoid (enteric) fever characterized by sustained high fever, relative bradycardia (Faget sign), rose spots, hepatosplenomegaly, and risk of intestinal perforation. Treatment for severe or invasive disease relies on fluoroquinolones, azithromycin, or third-generation cephalosporins.

Alternate Names:
Salmonella Infections; Salmonellosis

Salmonella Infections

Plural form; see *Salmonella Infection*.

Salmonella Typhi

The bacterium that causes typhoid fever, usually acquired through contaminated food or water and capable of spreading through the bloodstream.

Salmonella Typhimurium

A common Salmonella serotype that usually causes foodborne gastroenteritis but can cause invasive disease in vulnerable people.

Salmonella Typhisuis

A Salmonella serotype mainly associated with swine; human infection is uncommon but may cause enteric or invasive disease.

Salmonella Vaccines

Vaccines used mainly to prevent typhoid fever, including typhoid conjugate, Vi polysaccharide, and oral live-attenuated vaccines; routine vaccination does not prevent all Salmonella gastroenteritis.

Salmonellosis

Infection with Salmonella bacteria, usually acquired from contaminated food, water, or contact with infected animals. Non-typhoidal infection commonly causes diarrhea, fever, and abdominal cramps; typhoidal Salmonella causes enteric fever. Some infections spread to the blood, especially in vulnerable people.

Salmon Patches

Flat pink or red capillary birthmarks, commonly on the eyelids, forehead, or nape; many fade during infancy.

Salpingectomy

Surgical removal of a fallopian tube. It may be used to treat a tubal ectopic pregnancy, hydrosalpinx, or other tubal disease. The approach and whether the tube is removed depend on the clinical condition, fertility plans, and the state of the opposite tube.

Salpingitis

Inflammation or infection of one or both fallopian tubes, usually as part of pelvic inflammatory disease spreading upward from the vagina or cervix. It may cause lower-abdominal pain, fever, unusual discharge, infertility, or pregnancy outside the uterus.

Salpingitis Isthmica Nodosa

A condition in which the narrow part of a fallopian tube becomes thickened and develops small side pockets. Its cause is uncertain. It is associated with infertility and a higher risk of pregnancy implanting in the tube.

Alternate Names:
SIN

Salpingography

Contrast imaging of the fallopian tubes, usually performed as part of hysterosalpingography to assess whether the tubes are open and to examine the uterine cavity.

Salpingo-Oophorectomy

Surgery to remove one or both fallopian tubes and ovaries. It may treat cancer, an ovarian or tubal problem, or reduce cancer risk in people with certain inherited gene changes. Removing both ovaries causes permanent loss of ovarian hormone production.

Salpingo-OöPhorectomy

Surgical removal of a fallopian tube and ovary, also called salpingo-oophorectomy.

Salpingostomy

An operation that opens a fallopian tube to remove an ectopic pregnancy while leaving the tube in place. It may preserve fertility in selected cases, but persistent pregnancy tissue, bleeding, scarring, or another ectopic pregnancy can occur.

Alternate Names:
Tubal Incision; Ectopic Tubostomy

Salt

An ionic chemical compound; dietary sodium chloride is essential in small amounts but excess intake can increase blood pressure.

Saltatory Conduction

The rapid movement of an electrical signal along a nerve fiber covered by myelin. The signal travels between small uncovered gaps in the covering, allowing fast communication with other nerves and muscles.

Salter-Harris Fracture

A bone fracture in a child or adolescent that involves the growth plate (physis), the specialized area of developing cartilage near the ends of long bones where new bone growth occurs. Because the growth plate is weaker than surrounding mature bone, fractures can pass through or compress this vulnerable area. Medical classification helps assess the injury and ensure proper healing, minimizing the risk of uneven bone growth or joint deformity.

Alternate Names:
Salter-Harris Fractures; Physeal Fracture; Growth Plate Fracture

Salter-Harris Fractures

Plural form; see *Salter-Harris Fracture*.

Salvage Therapy

Treatment used when a disease, especially cancer, has not improved with earlier treatment or has returned. The choice depends on the disease, previous treatments, overall health, and treatment goals.

SAM-e

Abbreviation; see *S-Adenosylmethionine*.

Sample Fixation

Preserving a tissue or cell sample soon after collection so it does not decay or change shape. The preserved sample can then be processed, stained, and examined under a microscope for diagnosis.

Samter Triad

A clinical symptom complex (aspirin-exacerbated respiratory disease / AERD) characterized by the triad of bronchial asthma, chronic rhinosinusitis with recurrent nasal polyposis, and acute severe bronchospasm or naso-ocular reactions following the ingestion of aspirin or nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs (NSAIDs).

Alternate Names:
Aspirin-Exacerbated Respiratory Disease; AERD

Sandfly Fever

An acute viral illness transmitted by phlebotomine sandflies, causing fever, headache, muscle pain, and sometimes rash.

Sandhoff Disease

A rare inherited disorder caused by deficiency of the beta-hexosaminidase A and B enzymes, usually due to variants in the *HEXB* gene. GM2 ganglioside then builds up in nerve cells, causing progressive loss of skills, weakness, seizures, and movement problems; age of onset and severity vary.

Sandifer Syndrome

Episodes of abnormal neck and back posturing, sometimes with twisting movements, associated

with gastroesophageal reflux in infants or young children. Episodes often occur during or after feeding; the posturing is not itself proof of a seizure.

Alternate Names:
Sandifer's Syndrome; Gastroesophageal Reflux Dystonia

Sandpaper Tooth

A tooth with a rough, grainy enamel surface that can hold plaque and feel uneven to the tongue. It may result from weak enamel, early mineral loss, fluorosis, or wear.

Sanfilippo Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder in which the body cannot break down part of a complex sugar. The buildup mainly affects the brain and causes progressive developmental and behavioral changes.

Alternate Names:
Mucopolysaccharidosis Type III; MPS III

Sanguiferous

Conveying or carrying blood, especially as applied to blood vessels. The term describes a vessel that transports blood; it does not mean fluid containing blood, for which *sanguineous* is used. Modern medical writing usually uses "blood-carrying" or names the vessel.

Sanguine

Older term meaning blood-red; see *Sanguineous*.

Sanguineous

Containing fresh blood. The term often describes red wound drainage and is distinct from serosanguineous drainage, which contains a mixture of blood and clear fluid. A large amount or sudden increase in sanguineous drainage may indicate ongoing bleeding, depending on the wound and clinical context.

Sanguinopurulent

Describes fluid containing both blood and pus, such as drainage from a wound. The appearance can vary with the amount of blood and pus. It differs from serosanguineous fluid, which contains serum and a small amount of blood. The term describes the fluid and does not identify its cause or location.

Sanitation

Public-health measures that safely manage human waste, water, food, hygiene, and environmental contamination to prevent infection and disease transmission.

SA Node

A small group of specialized cells in the upper right heart chamber that normally starts each heartbeat. It produces regular electrical signals that spread through the heart and coordinate its rhythm.

Sano Shunt

A temporary tube connecting the lower-right heart chamber to the lung artery during the first operation for some babies with severe left-sided heart defects. It sends blood to the lungs while the heart is reconstructed; blockage or abnormal flow can be dangerous.

Alternate Names:
RV-PA Conduit; Norwood-Sano Modification

Santorini Duct

An accessory pancreatic duct that drains the anterosuperior head of the pancreas directly into the duodenum via the minor duodenal papilla (located approximately 2 cm proximal to the major duodenal papilla of Vater).

Alternate Names:
Accessory Pancreatic Duct; Duct of Santorini

Saphenous

Relating to the superficial veins of the lower limb, especially the great or small saphenous vein.

Saphenous Nerve

The largest cutaneous sensory terminal branch of the femoral nerve, descending through the adductor canal and piercing the deep fascia at the knee to travel alongside the great saphenous vein, supplying sensation to the medial lower leg, ankle, and medial

foot arch.

Saphenous Vein

A superficial vein of the lower limb that drains the foot and leg. The great and small saphenous veins are clinically important in venous disease and may be used as graft material in selected vascular or cardiac bypass procedures.

SAPHO Syndrome

A rare inflammatory condition combining bone or joint pain with acne or pus-filled skin lesions. It often affects the breastbone, collarbone, spine, or jaw and can resemble infection or cancer, so diagnosis and treatment require specialist assessment.

Sapovirus

A virus that can cause vomiting and watery diarrhea, especially in children. It spreads through contaminated food, water, surfaces, or close contact.

Sapovirus Infection

An acute enteric infection caused by sapoviruses, positive-sense single-stranded RNA viruses in the family Caliciviridae that infect humans across all age groups. Clinical manifestations include acute watery diarrhea, nausea, vomiting, abdominal cramping, and low-grade fever, often responsible for outbreaks of foodborne or waterborne gastroenteritis in daycares, schools, and hospitals that resolve with supportive rehydration within 48 to 72 hours.

Alternate Names:
Sapovirus Gastroenteritis; Human Sapovirus Infection

Sapropterin

A synthetic form of tetrahydrobiopterin used for some people with phenylketonuria and certain tetrahydrobiopterin deficiencies; response and diet requirements vary.

Saquinavir

An HIV protease inhibitor used with other antiretroviral medicines; drug interactions, gastrointestinal effects, and cardiovascular concerns limit its use.

Saquinavir Mesylate

The mesylate salt form of saquinavir, an HIV medicine that blocks viral protein processing. It is used with other antiretroviral drugs, but interactions, liver problems, and dangerous heart-rhythm changes require careful monitoring.

Sarcocystis Hominis

A protozoan parasite acquired by eating undercooked beef; people may develop intestinal symptoms, while cattle serve as an intermediate host.

Sarcocystis Suihominis

A protozoan parasite acquired by eating undercooked pork that can cause intestinal sarcocystosis; pigs serve as an intermediate host.

Sarcocystosis

Parasitic infection by Sarcocystis species, acquired from undercooked meat or contaminated food and sometimes causing muscle pain, fever, diarrhea, or no symptoms.

Sarcoglycan Complex

A group of proteins that helps strengthen the outer covering of muscle cells during movement. Inherited problems with these proteins can cause progressive muscle weakness and sometimes heart-muscle disease.

Sarcoglycanopathy

A group of inherited muscle diseases caused by changes in sarcoglycan genes. They usually cause progressive weakness of the hips and shoulders and may affect the heart.

Alternate Names:
Sarcoglycan-Deficient Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophy; LGMD R3-R6

Sarcoid Arthropathy

Joint inflammation associated with sarcoidosis. It may cause joint pain or swelling, often at the ankles during acute disease, and can occur with other sarcoidosis findings.

Sarcoid Of Boeck

Historical name for sarcoidosis, an inflammatory disease in which clusters of immune cells form in organs such as the lungs, lymph nodes, skin, or eyes.

Sarcoidosis

An inflammatory disease characterized by the formation of tiny, microscopic clumps of inflammatory cells, called granulomas, in various organs of the body. While it most frequently affects the lungs and nearby lymph nodes in the chest, it can also involve the skin, eyes, heart, liver, and nervous system. As granulomas accumulate, they can alter the normal structure and function of the affected organ, causing symptoms such as persistent dry cough, shortness of breath, fatigue, swollen lymph nodes, painful skin rashes, or vision changes.

Alternate Names:
Besnier-Boeck-Schaumann Disease; Boeck Sarcoid

Sarcoidosis Skin Manifestations

Skin involvement in sarcoidosis can cause firm bumps, raised or discolored patches, scars that change, or lupus pernio on the nose or face. The appearance varies and may require a skin examination or biopsy.

Sarcolemma

The thin outer covering of a muscle cell. It carries electrical signals that start contraction and helps maintain the cell's structure and internal chemical balance.

Sarcoma

A malignant tumor arising from connective or supporting tissues, including bone, cartilage, fat, muscle, and blood vessels. Examples include osteosarcoma, liposarcoma, and rhabdomyosarcoma.

Sarcomere

The smallest working unit that makes skeletal and heart muscle contract. It contains protein threads that slide past one another, shortening the muscle and producing force.

Sarcopenia

Loss of muscle strength and muscle mass that reduces physical function, often with aging but also with inactivity, poor nutrition, or chronic disease. It can cause weakness, slower walking, falls, and difficulty with daily activities.

Sarcopenic Obesity

Excess body fat together with low muscle mass, strength, or physical ability. It can increase the risk of falls, disability, metabolic disease, and complications after surgery.

Sarcoplasm

The material inside a muscle cell surrounding its specialized structures. It contains energy-producing parts, stored fuel, oxygen-holding myoglobin, and the protein machinery that produces contraction.

Sarcoplasmic Reticulum

A network inside muscle cells that stores calcium. It releases calcium to start contraction and takes calcium back up so the muscle can relax.

Sarcoptes

The mite genus containing Sarcoptes scabiei, the cause of scabies.

Sarcoptes Scabiei

The microscopic mite that causes scabies. It burrows into the outer layer of skin and lays eggs, producing intense itching and a rash or thin lines. It spreads mainly through prolonged close skin contact.

Sarcoptic Mange

Alternate name; see *Scabies*.

Sargramostim

A recombinant granulocyte-macrophage colony-stimulating factor used to promote white-cell recovery after selected cancer treatments or transplantation; bone pain and fever may occur.

Sarnat Staging

A three-level examination used to describe the sever-

ity of brain dysfunction in a newborn after reduced oxygen or blood flow. Mild disease causes increased alertness, moderate disease causes poor responsiveness and seizures, and severe disease causes coma and weak or absent reflexes; the stage helps guide urgent treatment and prognosis.

Alternate Names:
Sarnat and Sarnat Grading; Sarnat Score; HIE Staging

SARS

Severe acute respiratory syndrome, a serious lung infection caused by the SARS coronavirus. It can cause fever, cough, breathing difficulty, and pneumonia and spreads mainly through close contact with respiratory droplets.

SARS-CoV-2

The coronavirus that causes COVID-19. It spreads mainly through particles released when an infected person breathes, talks, coughs, or sneezes and can cause anything from no symptoms to severe lung or other organ disease.

SARS (Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome)

Alternate name; see *Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome*.

SARS Virus

SARS-associated coronavirus (SARS-CoV, also called SARS-CoV-1), the virus responsible for the 2002–2004 outbreak of severe acute respiratory syndrome. It is distinct from SARS-CoV-2, which causes COVID-19.

Sartorius Muscle

A long, narrow muscle that runs diagonally across the front of the thigh from the pelvis to the inner side of the upper shin. It bends the hip and knee, moves the thigh away from the body, and turns it outward.

Alternate Names:
Tailor's Muscle

Sassafras Oil Overdose

Poisoning from swallowing or otherwise being exposed to too much sassafras oil. It may cause nausea, vomiting, seizures, breathing problems, liver injury, or other serious effects.

Satellite DNA

Repeated stretches of DNA found mainly in tightly packed parts of chromosomes. They help organize chromosome structure and can vary between people, usually without providing instructions for making proteins.

Satellite Virus

A small virus-like infectious agent that can multiply only when a separate helper virus is present. It uses the helper's machinery and may change how severe or persistent the combined infection becomes.

Satiation

The feeling of fullness that terminates a meal, produced by gastrointestinal stretch, nutrients, hormones, and brain signals regulating food intake.

Satiety

The feeling of fullness that reduces the desire to eat after a meal. It is influenced by stomach stretching, food composition, hormones, and brain signals; persistent early fullness can indicate illness.

Saturated Fat

A dietary fat whose fatty-acid chains contain no carbon-carbon double bonds. It is found in foods such as fatty meat, butter, full-fat dairy, coconut oil, and palm oil; replacing some saturated fat with unsaturated fat can help lower LDL cholesterol and cardiovascular risk.

Saturation

A state in which available binding, transport, or processing capacity is nearly full. Once capacity is reached, extra medicine or substance may remain in the blood or produce a disproportionately larger effect.

Sausage Digit

Diffuse swelling of an entire finger or toe, often caused by inflammation in joints, tendons, and surrounding tissues.

Alternate Names:
Dactylitis

Saxitoxin

A powerful poison made by some marine algae that can build up in shellfish. Eating contaminated seafood may cause tingling, weakness, trouble breathing, or paralysis.

SBBO

Alternate name; see *Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth*.

Scab

A crust of dried blood, serum, pus, or tissue fluid over a healing skin injury.

Scabies

An infestation of the skin by the human itch mite *Sarcoptes scabiei* var. *hominis*, which burrows into the outer skin layer. It causes intense, often nocturnal itching and a papular rash; thin, winding burrows may be visible. Transmission occurs mainly through prolonged direct skin-to-skin contact.

Alternate Names:
Sarcoptic Acariasis; Seven-Year Itch

SCAD

Alternate name; see *Spontaneous Coronary Artery Dissection*.

Scaffold

A three-dimensional framework used in tissue engineering to hold cells in place while they grow and organize into new tissue. It may be made from natural or synthetic material and may gradually dissolve.

Scaffold Seeding

Placing living cells onto or inside a three-dimensional framework so they can attach, multiply, and begin forming tissue in laboratory or regenerative-medicine research.

SCAI Shock Stages

A consensus system for classifying cardiogenic shock from stage A (at risk) through stage B (beginning), C (classic), D (deteriorating), and E (extremis), using clinical and hemodynamic findings to describe severity and progression.

Alternate Names:
SCAI Cardiogenic Shock Stages; SCAI Shock Classification

Scalded Mouth Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Burning Mouth Syndrome*.

Scalded Skin Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Scalded-Skin Syndrome*.

Scalded-Skin Syndrome

A serious infection, usually in young children, in which toxins from Staphylococcus bacteria make the outer skin layer separate. The skin becomes painful, red, and easily blistered or peeled; fluid loss and secondary infection are possible complications.

Scalds

Burns caused by hot liquids or steam. They may damage only the surface skin or extend into deeper tissue; severity depends on depth, size, location, and age. Large, deep, facial, genital, hand, or circumferential burns can cause major tissue injury; unusual patterns in children may indicate inflicted injury.

Scalene Muscles

A group of three paired cervical muscles (anterior, middle, and posterior scalenes) originating from cervical transverse processes and inserting onto the first and second ribs; the interscalene triangle between the anterior and middle scalenes transmits the brachial plexus roots and subclavian artery (site of thoracic outlet syndrome).

Scales

Scales are flakes or plates of shed skin on the surface,

occurring with dryness, eczema, psoriasis, fungal infection, or other dermatologic conditions.

Scaling

Scaling is flaking or shedding of the outer skin layer and may occur with dryness, eczema, psoriasis, fungal infection, or other skin disease.

Scaling And Root Planing

A deep dental cleaning that removes hardened plaque and bacteria above and below the gumline and smooths tooth roots. It reduces gum inflammation and may slow periodontal disease, but severe damage may need additional treatment.

Scalp

The skin and underlying tissues covering the skull. It contains hair follicles, glands, blood vessels, nerves, and connective tissue and can be affected by injury, infection, or skin disease.

Scalp and Body Ringworm

Alternate name; see *Ringworm*.

Scalpel

A sharp surgical knife used to make precise incisions or cuts in tissue. It may be a reusable handle with a detachable blade or a disposable single-piece instrument. Blade designs and numbers differ in size and shape; for example, a No. 10 blade is commonly used for larger incisions, a No. 11 for puncture or stab incisions, and a No. 15 for shorter precise cuts.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Knife; Lancette

Scalpel Handle

The reusable handle that holds a detachable scalpel blade. Different handle and blade sizes are chosen for the type and precision of the incision.

Scalp Psoriasis

Psoriasis affecting the scalp, causing sharply demarcated red plaques covered by silvery scale that may extend beyond the hairline. It can itch, crack, or bleed and is not contagious. Treatment may include medicated shampoos, topical corticosteroids, vitamin-D analogues, or systemic therapy for extensive disease.

Alternate Names:
Scalp Plaque Psoriasis

Scalp Ringworm

A contagious fungal infection of the scalp, also called tinea capitis. It can cause scaling, itching, broken hairs, bald patches, or swollen tender areas; oral antifungal treatment is used because topical medicines do not reach infected hair follicles well.

Scalp Tenderness

Pain when the scalp is touched or brushed. It can occur with giant cell arteritis, migraine, skin problems, nerve pain, or other conditions, so it is not diagnostic by itself.

Scan

An imaging examination that creates pictures of body structures or functions using methods such as ultrasound, X-rays, CT, MRI, or radioactive tracers. The method and interpretation depend on the clinical question.

Scan Gallium

A nuclear-medicine scan using radiolabeled gallium to identify areas of inflammation, infection, or some tumors; uptake is interpreted with anatomy and clinical context.

Scanning

Systematic examination of a body region or specimen using imaging, microscopy, or another detection method to locate, characterize, or monitor abnormalities.

Scanning Electron Microscopy

A method that scans a specimen's surface with an electron beam to produce a highly magnified, three-dimensional-looking image of its shape and surface details.

Scanning Speech

Speech that is unusually slow, broken into separate syllables, and spoken with uneven rhythm or emphasis. It can occur when disease affects the cerebellum or other parts of the nervous system.

Scanning Techniques

Methods used to create images or measurements of the body or a sample. Examples include ultrasound, X-ray, CT, MRI, and nuclear-medicine scans; the method is chosen according to the clinical question.

Scaphoid

A small wrist bone on the thumb side, commonly injured when someone falls onto an outstretched hand. Pain in the hollow just behind the thumb may indicate a fracture, which sometimes heals poorly because part of the bone has limited blood flow.

Scaphoid Abdomen

A scaphoid abdomen is an unusually hollowed abdominal contour, classically seen with severe diaphragmatic hernia in a newborn but also possible with marked wasting.

Scaphoid Bone

The largest proximal-row carpal bone on the thumb side of the wrist; its waist is vulnerable to fracture and avascular necrosis because of its blood supply.

Scaphoid Fractures

Breaks in the small wrist bone near the base of the thumb, often after falling onto an outstretched hand. Pain may be felt in the hollow beside the thumb; some fractures heal poorly because part of the bone has a limited blood supply.

Scapholunate Advanced Collapse

A pattern of wrist arthritis that can develop after a long-standing tear between two wrist bones or an unhealed scaphoid fracture. It causes pain and stiffness that gradually worsen; X-rays show a characteristic pattern of joint wear.

Alternate Names:
SLAC Wrist; Scapholunate Collapse Arthropathy

Scaphycephaly

A long, narrow head shape caused when the major seam running from front to back of the skull closes too early. It is a form of craniosynostosis and may require specialist assessment to protect brain and skull development.

Scapula

The shoulder blade, a flat triangular bone at the back of the chest. It connects the upper arm to the collarbone and provides attachment for muscles that move and stabilize the shoulder.

Scapular Winging

Prominence of the shoulder blade away from the back of the chest, often noticed when pushing against a wall or raising the arm. It may result from weakness of the muscles that stabilize the shoulder blade, including after nerve injury.

Scapulothoracic Joint

The functional gliding connection between the shoulder blade and the back of the chest wall. It is not a true joint but works with nearby joints to position and move the arm.

Scar

An area of fibrous tissue that replaces normal dermal or parenchymal architecture following tissue injury, ulceration, or surgical incision, representing the final endpoint of wound healing. Characterized pathologically by dense collagen deposition (predominantly type I collagen replacing type III collagen) with loss of normal skin appendages (hair follicles and sweat glands) and elastic fibers. Abnormal scarring includes atrophic scars, hypertrophic scars (fibrous tissue confined within original wound borders), and keloids (excessive, nodular fibroblastic proliferation extending beyond initial wound boundaries).

Alternate Names:
Scars; Cicatrix

Scarlatina

Scarlet fever, an illness caused by toxin-producing group A Streptococcus and characterized by sore throat, fever, and a fine rough-textured rash.

Alternate Names:
Scarlet Fever; Second Disease

Scarlet Fever

An illness caused by toxin-producing group A Streptococcus. It usually causes sore throat, fever, and a widespread fine, rough-textured rash; a red tongue and pale skin around the mouth may also occur.

Scar Revision

A procedure that improves the appearance, contour, flexibility, or symptoms of a scar through excision, rearrangement, grafting, laser, injection, or other selected techniques.

Scarring Alopecia

Permanent hair loss caused when inflammation or injury destroys hair follicles and replaces them with scar tissue. Early scalp redness, scaling, itching, pain, or spreading hair loss needs dermatologic assessment because lost follicles cannot regrow hair.

Scarring Bullosa

An older, nonspecific term for blistering disorders that heal with scars. Use the specific diagnosis, such as epidermolysis bullosa acquisita or mucous membrane pemphigoid, when known.

Scars

Plural form; see *Scar*.

Scatter Correction

A medical-imaging method that estimates and reduces errors caused when detected radiation changes direction after passing through tissue. It can improve the accuracy of a nuclear-medicine image or measured activity.

Scatter Events

Radiation particles that change direction after interacting with tissue or another material. In medical imaging they can place signals in the wrong location or reduce contrast, so scanners use design and correction methods to limit their effect.

Scavenger Receptor

A protein on or inside a cell that recognizes and helps remove altered fats, germs, cell debris, or dying cells. It supports early immune defense but can also help fatty material build up in artery walls.

Scavenging System

Equipment that collects and removes waste anesthetic gases from an operating room. It protects staff from repeated exposure and may use a vacuum system or passive venting to carry gases safely away.

Scedosporium

A genus of environmental molds that can cause difficult-to-treat lung, sinus, skin, bone, or disseminated infections, especially in immunocompromised people.

Scedosporium Apiospermum

A mold that can cause localized or disseminated infection, including mycetoma, pneumonia, sinusitis, and brain abscesses; treatment often requires specialist antifungal care.

Schaalia Radingae

A normally slow-growing anaerobic bacterium of the human mouth and skin that can rarely cause abscesses or other invasive infections.

Schaalia Turicensis

A filamentous anaerobic bacterium that may be part of normal flora but can cause actinomycosis-like abscesses and other opportunistic infections.

Schatzki Ring

A thin ring of tissue narrowing the lower esophagus, often near a hiatus hernia. It may cause occasional difficulty swallowing solid food or a piece of food becoming stuck; treatment can widen the narrowed area.

Alternate Names:
Lower Esophageal Mucosal Ring; B Ring

Schereshevkii-Turner Syndrome

Variant spelling of an older name; see *Turner Syn-*

drome.

Scheuermann Disease

A juvenile osteochondrosis of the spine in which vertebral end plates develop irregularities and anterior wedging during skeletal growth. It commonly produces a rigid thoracic kyphosis, although the thoracolumbar or lumbar spine may also be involved. Symptoms can include back pain, fatigue, limited spinal motion, and postural deformity that becomes more apparent during adolescence. Diagnosis is based on clinical examination and characteristic radiographs; management depends on deformity severity, skeletal maturity, pain, and progression.

Scheuermann's Disease

A growth disorder beginning in adolescence that causes several spinal bones to become wedge-shaped. This can produce a lasting rounded upper back, stiffness, pain, and sometimes breathing or activity limitations.

Schiff Base

A chemical compound formed when a primary amine reacts with an aldehyde or ketone; Schiff bases occur in biochemistry and drug chemistry.

Schiller Test

An examination of the cervix in which iodine solution is applied to highlight areas of abnormal tissue. Areas that do not stain may need further examination or biopsy; the test alone cannot diagnose cancer.

Schilling Test

An older test that measured how well the body absorbed vitamin B12, sometimes used to investigate pernicious anemia or intestinal disease. It is rarely performed now because blood tests and antibody testing have largely replaced it.

Schirmer Test

A test in which standardized filter paper strips measure tear production over a set time, commonly used to evaluate aqueous-deficient dry eye.

Schistocyte Count

Measurement of fragmented red blood cells on a blood smear, supporting evaluation of microangiopathic hemolysis, mechanical valve damage, disseminated intravascular coagulation, or severe burns.

Schistocytes

Broken, irregular, or helmet-shaped red blood cells seen on a blood-smear test. They form when red cells are damaged in abnormal small vessels, by artificial heart valves, or in other illnesses and may signal serious red-cell destruction.

Schistomicide

A medicine that kills parasitic blood flukes responsible for schistosomiasis. Treatment choice depends on the parasite species and the organs affected, and medical advice is needed because infection may cause lasting damage.

Schistosoma

A group of parasitic worms that live in blood vessels. Their young forms can enter through skin exposed to contaminated fresh water and later cause intestinal, urinary, liver, or other disease.

Schistosoma Haematobium

A parasitic blood fluke that can cause urinary schistosomiasis, including hematuria and chronic injury of the urinary tract.

Schistosoma Intercalatum

A parasitic blood fluke that causes intestinal schistosomiasis, mainly in parts of Central and West Africa, after freshwater exposure.

Schistosomiasis

An infection caused by parasitic worms called *Schistosoma*. The worms' eggs hatch in freshwater and infect snails; larvae released by the snails can penetrate human skin during contact with contaminated water. Adult worms live in blood vessels, and their eggs can damage the intestine, liver, urinary tract, or other organs. Symptoms may include an itchy rash, fever, abdominal pain, diarrhea, or blood in the stool or urine.

Schistosomiasis (Bilharzia)

Alternate name; see *Schistosomiasis*.

Alternate Names:
Snail Fever

Schizencephaly

A rare brain-development condition in which a cleft lined by abnormal gray matter extends from a brain ventricle to the brain's outer surface. The cleft may be open or closed and can cause seizures, weakness, movement problems, or developmental delay, depending on its size and location.

Schizoaffective Disorder

A psychotic disorder in which schizophrenia symptoms occur during major depressive or manic episodes, while delusions or hallucinations also persist for at least two weeks without a major mood episode. Major mood episodes occupy most of the illness's active and residual course. The disorder has depressive and bipolar types.

Schizogony

A way some single-celled parasites reproduce without mating. One parasite cell grows and divides internally to produce many new cells, which are then released to infect other cells.

Schizoid Personality Disorder

A long-standing pattern of limited interest in close relationships and restricted emotional expression. It differs from schizophrenia because hallucinations and fixed delusions are not central features.

Alternate Names:
Schizoid Disorder; Asocial Personality

Schizophrenia

A serious, long-term mental disorder that can affect a person's thoughts, perceptions, emotions, behavior, and ability to function. Symptoms are often grouped as psychotic, negative, and cognitive. Psychotic symptoms include hallucinations, such as hearing or seeing things that others do not, delusions, which are firmly held beliefs not supported by shared evidence, and disorganized thought or speech. Negative symptoms may include reduced emotional expression, motivation, pleasure, or social interest. Cognitive symptoms may affect attention, memory, planning, and decision-making. Symptoms and their severity vary between people and may come and go or persist over time.

Schizophreniform Disorder

A psychotic disorder with symptoms such as delusions, hallucinations, disorganized speech or behavior, and reduced functioning lasting at least one month but less than six months. The duration distinguishes it from schizophrenia; symptoms are not better explained by a mood disorder, substance, medication, or another medical condition.

Schizotypal Personality Disorder

A long-term pattern of discomfort with close relationships, unusual beliefs or perceptions, unusual speech or behavior, and difficulty interpreting social situations. It is different from schizophrenia because persistent hallucinations and major loss of reality testing are not typical.

Alternate Names:
Schizotypal Disorder; STPD

Schlemm Canal

A circular, endothelium-lined vessel situated in the iridocorneal angle of the anterior chamber, which drains aqueous humor from the trabecular meshwork into the collector channels and episcleral venous system.

Alternate Names:
Canal of Schlemm; Scleral Venous Sinus

Schlemm'S Canal

A circular drainage channel at the edge of the cornea that carries fluid from the front of the eye into blood vessels. Poor drainage can raise pressure inside the eye and contribute to glaucoma.

Alternate Names:
Canal of Schlemm

Schmorl Node

An intravertebral disc herniation characterized by the protrusion and displacement of nucleus pulposus cartilage through a defect in the cartilaginous

vertebral endplate into the trabecular bone marrow of an adjacent vertebral body.

Alternate Names:
Schmorl's Node; Intravertebral Herniation

Schnitzler Syndrome

A rare inflammatory disease causing a long-lasting hives-like rash, repeated fever, bone or joint pain, and raised inflammation tests. It is usually associated with an abnormal IgM blood protein.

School-Age Children Development

School-age development includes advances in growth, coordination, language, learning, independence, social relationships, and emotional regulation, with broad normal variation.

School-Based Rehabilitation

Therapy and other support services provided in a school setting to help a child participate in education and daily school activities.

School Sores

Alternate name; see *Impetigo*.

Schwann Cell

The principal neuroglial cell of the peripheral nervous system (PNS), derived from neural crest cells during embryogenesis. Myelinating Schwann cells wrap repeatedly around a single segment of a large-caliber axon to form a concentric myelin sheath, facilitating rapid saltatory nerve impulse conduction across the nodes of Ranvier. Non-myelinating Schwann cells engulf and mechanically bundle multiple small-caliber unmyelinated axons (Remak bundles). Schwann cells also play a pivotal role in post-traumatic peripheral axon regeneration by guiding sprouting axon growth cones; neoplastic proliferation yields schwannomas and neurofibromas.

Alternate Names:
Schwann Cells; Neurolemmocyte

Schwann Cells

Plural form; see *Schwann Cell*.

Schwannoma

A usually noncancerous, slow-growing tumor arising from cells that support nerves. It may cause a lump, pain, numbness, or weakness; a tumor involving the hearing and balance nerve can cause hearing loss, ringing, or dizziness.

Alternate Names:
Neurilemmoma

Schwannomatosis

A condition in which multiple schwannomas, usually slow-growing tumors of the covering of nerves, develop. The main problem is often long-lasting pain, although numbness, weakness, or other nerve symptoms can occur depending on tumor location.

Alternate Names:
Neurinomatosis

SCI

Alternate name; see *Spinal Cord Injury*.

Sciatica

Pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness that travels from the lower back or buttock down the leg, usually because a nerve root is irritated by a disk problem or narrowing of the spine. Progressive weakness, numbness around the inner thighs or genitals, or new loss of bladder or bowel control may indicate severe nerve compression.

Alternate Names:
Sciatic Neuralgia

Sciatic Nerve

The body's largest nerve, running from the lower spine through the buttock and down the back of the leg. It supplies movement and sensation to much of the leg and foot.

Sciatic Neuritis

Alternate name; see *Sciatica*.

Scimitar Syndrome

A congenital condition in which one or more veins from the right lung drain into the inferior vena cava instead of the left atrium. The right lung may

be underdeveloped, and the condition can cause repeated chest infections, breathing problems, high pressure in the lung arteries, or heart failure.

Scintigraphy

Nuclear-medicine imaging in which a small amount of radioactive tracer is given and a camera records where it collects. The pattern can show the function, blood flow, or activity of organs such as bone, thyroid, kidneys, or heart.

Scintillation

A localized flash or emission of light; in nuclear medicine, the flash of luminescence produced in a luminescent crystal (e.g., sodium iodide crystal activated with thallium) when struck by an ionizing photon or particle. In ophthalmology and neurology, scintillation denotes a visual phenomenon of twinkling, flashing, or shimmering zigzag lines of light (scintillating scotoma or teichopsia), classically experienced during the aura phase of a migraine attack.

Alternate Names:
Scintillations; Scintillating Scotoma; Teichopsia

Scintillation Crystal

A material in some medical detectors that changes incoming radiation into tiny flashes of light. The flashes are measured to create images or estimate the amount of radioactive tracer present.

Scintillations

Plural form; see *Scintillation*.

Scirrhus

An older term for a hard cancer containing a large amount of scar-like tissue. It was used especially for some breast or stomach cancers and describes texture rather than a separate cancer type.

Scissors

Instruments with two blades used to cut tissue, sutures, dressings, or other material. Surgical types vary in length, blade shape, and sharpness; examples include Mayo and Metzenbaum scissors.

Sclera

The sclera is the tough white outer coat of the eye that protects the globe and provides attachment for eye muscles.

Scleral Buckling

A retinal-detachment repair procedure in which a silicone band or buckle is placed around the outside of the eye to support the retinal break and reduce traction.

Scleral Icterus

Yellowing of the whites of the eyes, caused by bilirubin building up in the body. It is a visible sign of jaundice, which can result from liver disease, bile-duct blockage, or increased breakdown of red blood cells.

Scleral Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Scleritis*.

Scleredema

A sclerosing skin disorder causing thick, hard, often waxy skin, classically on the neck, upper back, and shoulders. It may follow infection, occur with diabetes or a monoclonal gammopathy, or rarely be associated with other systemic disease.

Scleredema Diabeticorum

Scleredema diabeticorum is thickening and hardening of the skin on the upper back and neck, usually associated with long-standing diabetes and obesity.

Scleritis

Inflammation of the sclera, the tough white outer wall of the eye. It often causes deep eye pain, redness, and tenderness and can threaten vision. It may be associated with autoimmune disease, infection, trauma, surgery, or medicines. Types include anterior and posterior scleritis; complications can include inflammation of nearby eye structures, scleral thinning, and vision loss.

Alternate Names:
Deep Scleral Inflammation; Scleral Inflammation

Sclerochoroidal Calcification

A rare ocular finding caused by calcium-salt deposits in the posterior sclera, sometimes extending into the choroid. It usually appears as yellow-white plaques in the peripheral fundus and is often asymptomatic; most cases are idiopathic, though some are associated with altered calcium-phosphate metabolism.

Sclerodactyly

Thick, tight skin on the fingers or toes, often making them shiny, tapered, or hard to bend. It commonly occurs in systemic sclerosis and may limit movement.

Scleroderma

A group of conditions that cause skin and sometimes deeper tissues to become hard, thick, or tight. Localized scleroderma, also called morphea, mainly affects the skin and nearby tissues. Systemic sclerosis can affect the skin, blood vessels, and internal organs such as the esophagus, lungs, kidneys, and heart. The cause is not fully known, and symptoms vary by type and organs involved.

Scleroderma Renal Crisis

A sudden, dangerous rise in blood pressure with rapid kidney failure in a person with systemic sclerosis. It may also damage blood cells and platelets. It is a medical emergency and is treated urgently, usually with an ACE-inhibitor medicine.

Alternate Names:
SRC; Systemic Sclerosis Renal Crisis

Scleroma

A long-lasting infection, usually of the nose and upper airway, caused by Klebsiella rhinoscleromatis. It can produce scar tissue, blocked breathing, nasal discharge, voice changes, or facial deformity.

Scleromyxedema

A rare long-term skin disorder in which many small, firm, waxy bumps and thickened skin develop, especially on the face, neck, and hands. It may also affect muscles, joints, swallowing, lungs, or other organs.

Sclerosing Adenosis

A benign breast condition in which scar-like fibrous tissue forms in the milk-producing lobules. It may cause a small lump or breast pain and is associated with a slight increase in breast cancer risk.

Sclerosing Cholangitis

Inflammation and scarring that narrow or block the tubes carrying bile from the liver. It may cause itching, jaundice, abdominal pain, repeated infections, and liver damage; the cause guides treatment and follow-up.

Sclerosing Mesenteritis

A rare inflammatory condition causing thickening and scarring in the tissue that supports the intestines. It may cause abdominal pain, nausea, weight loss, or bowel blockage, although some people have no symptoms.

Sclerosing Peritonitis

Thickening and scarring of the lining inside the abdomen, sometimes after long-term peritoneal dialysis. The scar tissue can restrict the intestines and cause pain, vomiting, poor nutrition, or bowel blockage.

Sclerosing Sialadenitis

Long-term inflammation that makes a salivary gland swollen and hard because scar-like tissue forms inside it. It may be related to an immune disorder and can cause dry mouth, pain, or repeated swelling.

Sclerosis

Abnormal hardening or scarring of tissue, often from excess connective tissue, chronic inflammation, degeneration, or neurologic plaques; the affected organ determines the specific disease.

Sclerosteosis

A rare inherited condition in which bones, especially the skull, become abnormally thick. It may cause a broad or tall build, joined fingers, headaches, hearing loss, facial weakness, or pressure on nerves inside the skull.

Sclerotherapy

A treatment in which an irritating or closing agent is injected into a blood vessel or body cavity to make it scar and seal, commonly used for varicose veins and selected vascular lesions.

Sclerotomy

A sclerotomy is a surgical opening made through the sclera, the white outer layer of the eye, often during vitreoretinal surgery.

Scoliosis

A structural sideways curve of the spine measuring more than 10 degrees by the Cobb method on X-ray, usually with vertebral rotation. It may be idiopathic, congenital, or neuromuscular; some curves cause no symptoms, while larger curves may change body shape and can rarely affect breathing.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Curvature

Scombroid Poisoning

An illness caused by eating fish, such as tuna or mackerel, that was not kept cold enough. Bacteria in the fish produce histamine that is not destroyed by cooking. Symptoms can begin within minutes and include flushing, headache, a peppery taste, rash, palpitations, and stomach cramps.

Alternate Names:
Histamine Fish Poisoning; Scombrotoxism

Scopolamine

Scopolamine is a muscarinic antagonist used mainly to prevent motion sickness and postoperative nausea; dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, confusion, and other anticholinergic effects may occur.

Scopolamine Hydrobromide

The hydrobromide salt of scopolamine, an anticholinergic medicine used mainly to prevent motion sickness and postoperative nausea.

Scopolamine Patch

A skin patch that slowly releases scopolamine, a medicine that blocks a nerve signal involved in nausea. In adults, it is used to prevent nausea and vomiting from motion sickness or after surgery. It can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, confusion, and overheating.

Alternate Names:
Scopolamine Transdermal Patch; Scopolamine Transdermal System

Scopulariopsis

Scopulariopsis is a mold genus that rarely causes opportunistic infection, especially in people with immune suppression or implanted devices.

Scorbutic

Relating to scurvy caused by severe vitamin C deficiency. It can cause easy bruising, bleeding gums, poor wound healing, anemia, bone or joint pain, and weakness; treatment with vitamin C and an adequate diet usually leads to recovery.

Scorpion Fish Sting

A painful injury from the venomous spines of a scorpion fish, causing severe local pain and swelling and sometimes whole-body symptoms. Spines or venom may remain in the injury.

Scorpions

Venomous arachnids whose stings can cause local pain and, depending on the species, sweating, muscle spasms, breathing problems, or other serious symptoms.

Scorpion Sting

A venomous injury from a scorpion, usually causing immediate pain, burning, redness, or tingling. Some species can cause muscle twitching, abnormal eye movements, breathing difficulty, or dangerous autonomic symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Scorpion Envenomation; Scorpion Bite

Scorpion Stings

Alternate name; see *Scorpion Sting*.

Scotoma

A blind or blurred spot within an otherwise usable field of vision. It may result from retinal disease, optic-nerve damage, migraine, stroke, or another eye or brain disorder.

Scotty Dog Sign

The normal radiological configuration of the posterior vertebral elements on oblique lumbar spine radiographs resembling a Scottish terrier dog; a radiolucent line crossing the neck of the dog indicates a defect or fracture in the pars interarticularis (spondylolysis).

Alternate Names:
Scottish Terrier Sign; Pars Interarticularis Collar Sign

Scrape

A scrape is a superficial abrasion in which friction removes part of the skin surface; cleaning, protection, and monitoring for infection support healing.

Screening

Testing people without symptoms to identify a disease or an increased risk of disease. The appropriate test, age range, interval, and follow-up depend on the condition, individual risk, and current guidance; screening benefits must be balanced against harms.

Screening And Diagnosis For HIV

Testing for human immunodeficiency virus using an antigen-antibody assay or nucleic-acid test, followed by confirmatory testing and assessment of immune status when positive.

Screening Procedure

A test or examination offered to people without symptoms to detect disease or risk early enough for effective prevention or treatment; eligibility and intervals depend on evidence and risk.

Screening Program

An organized public-health service that systematically invites a defined population to undergo testing for an asymptomatic condition, with quality-assured follow-up, diagnosis, treatment, and evaluation of benefits and harms.

Screening Study

A planned investigation of an asymptomatic population to identify early disease, precursor lesions, or risk factors using a validated test and follow-up pathway.

Screening Test

A test applied to people without symptoms or a known diagnosis to identify those at increased risk of a condition. A screening result usually requires a diagnostic or confirmatory evaluation before treatment is initiated.

Screening Tests for Depression

Alternate name; see *Depression Screening*.

Screen Time And Children

Time children spend using televisions, computers, phones, tablets, or game devices; excessive or poorly timed use can affect sleep, activity, learning, mood, and family routines.

Screws

Threaded metal devices used to hold broken bones together or attach plates and other implants securely to bone.

Script

A script is a written set of instructions or a prescription; in healthcare, a prescription specifies the medicine, dose, route, timing, and duration.

Scrivener's Palsy

An older term for task-specific hand dystonia or cramp occurring during writing.

Scrofuloderma

A form of skin tuberculosis caused when infection in a nearby lymph node, bone, or joint spreads directly into the skin. It often begins as a firm lump that softens, breaks open, and forms a draining sore or tunnel; neck lymph nodes are a common source.

Scrotal Calcinosis

Firm, usually painless calcium deposits in the skin of the scrotum that appear as one or more whitish or yellowish lumps. They may become tender, ulcerate, or release a chalky material; removal is considered if they cause symptoms.

Scrotal Infection

Infection of the scrotal skin or underlying structures, which may cause redness, swelling, warmth, pain, or drainage. Rapidly worsening pain, fever, discoloration, or severe swelling is an emergency because serious soft-tissue infection must be excluded.

Scrotal Masses

Lumps or swellings in the scrotum, arising from the skin, fluid around a testicle, veins, infection, hernia, or a testicular tumor. A firm, painless, or rapidly growing lump can occur with a testicular tumor.

Scrotal Pain

Pain in the scrotum caused by infection, trauma, hernia, fluid collections, varicocele, testicular torsion, or other conditions affecting the testes and surrounding structures.

Scrotal Septum

A tissue wall that divides the scrotum into right and left compartments.

Scrotal Swelling

Enlargement of the scrotum caused by fluid, inflammation, infection, hernia, varicocele, hydrocele, tumor, trauma, or testicular torsion; sudden pain is an emergency.

Scrotal Ultrasound

Ultrasound imaging of the scrotum and testes used to evaluate pain, swelling, masses, torsion, infection, trauma, and blood flow.

Scrotum

The scrotum is the external skin-and-muscle sac containing the testes and epididymides; its muscles help regulate testicular temperature, and swelling or pain may indicate infection, torsion, hernia, or tumor.

Scrub In

To scrub in is to perform surgical hand antisepsis and put on sterile clothing and gloves before participating in a sterile procedure.

Scrubs

Scrubs are protective work garments commonly worn by healthcare staff; they reduce clothing contamination but do not replace hand hygiene or other precautions.

Scrub Typhus

An infection spread by tiny mites called chiggers. It can cause high fever, headache, swollen lymph nodes, rash, and sometimes a dark sore at the bite site. Severe illness can affect the lungs, kidneys, heart, or brain; untreated disease can be fatal.

Alternate Names:
Tsutsugamushi Disease; Mite-Borne Typhus

Scrub Up

To scrub up means to clean and antiseptically prepare the hands and forearms before a sterile procedure.

Scurf

Fine flakes or scales shed from the skin, especially the scalp. It may occur with dry skin, dandruff, eczema, psoriasis, infection, or irritation and may be accompanied by itching or redness.

Scurvy

A disease caused by severe vitamin C deficiency. It can cause bleeding or swollen gums, easy bruising, small skin bleeds, poor wound healing, anemia, bone or joint pain, and fatigue.

Seabather's Eruption

An itchy papular or vesicular eruption caused by contact with stinging larvae in seawater, often beneath swimwear. Symptoms may begin after leaving the water and usually resolve over days; extensive

reactions can cause marked inflammation.

Sea-Blue Histiocyte

An immune cell that appears blue-green under a microscope because it contains stored fats or cell-waste pigment. It may be seen in some storage, blood, or metabolic disorders, but the finding alone does not identify a disease.

Seafood Poisoning

Clinical toxic syndromes resulting from the ingestion of seafood containing marine toxins or accumulated bio-toxins, including ciguatera fish poisoning, scombroid (histamine) toxicity, paralytic shellfish poisoning, and tetrodotoxin poisoning.

Alternate Names:
Marine Toxin Poisoning; Shellfish Toxicity; Ichthyosarcotoxism

Sea-Sickness

Motion sickness caused by conflicting signals from the inner ear, eyes, and body during travel on a boat or ship. It may cause nausea, vomiting, dizziness, sweating, headache, and pallor.

Seasonal Affective Disorder

Depression that repeatedly begins during a particular season, most often autumn or winter, and improves at another time of year. Symptoms may include low mood, loss of interest, tiredness, oversleeping, increased appetite, and social withdrawal.

Seasonal Affective Disorder (SAD)

Alternate name; see *Seasonal Affective Disorder*.

Seasonal Affective Disorder Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Seasonal Affective Disorder*.

Seasonal Allergies

An allergic reaction that occurs at specific times of the year when outdoor plants release tiny pollen grains into the air. In spring, tree pollen (such as oak, birch, and cedar) is the most common trigger; in summer, grass pollen causes symptoms; and in late summer and autumn, weed pollen (especially ragweed) and outdoor mold spores are common culprits. When a sensitized person inhales pollen, the immune system mistakenly identifies it as a threat, causing the release of histamine and other chemicals that inflame the nasal passages, sinuses, and eyes. Common symptoms include frequent sneezing, a congested or runny nose with clear drainage, an itchy throat or roof of the mouth, and red, itchy, watery eyes (allergic conjunctivitis).

Alternate Names:
Hay Fever; Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis; Pollinosis; Seasonal Allergy

Sebaceous Adenoma

A sebaceous adenoma is a usually benign tumor of sebaceous glands that can appear as a yellowish skin nodule and may be associated with Muir-Torre syndrome.

Sebaceous Carcinoma

An uncommon cancer arising from sebaceous, or oil-producing, glands. It often appears as a firm or yellowish eyelid or skin nodule and may require biopsy and specialist treatment.

Sebaceous Cyst

A common but imprecise term for an epidermoid cyst, a keratin-filled cyst beneath the skin.

Sebaceous Epithelioma

A benign sebaceous neoplasm, often presenting as a yellowish papule or nodule. Multiple or unusual lesions may warrant assessment for a DNA mismatch-repair syndrome such as Muir-Torre syndrome.

Sebaceous Gland

A microscopic exocrine holocrine gland located in the dermis of the skin, usually connected to a hair follicle to form a pilosebaceous unit (with specialized free sebaceous glands occurring in the eyelids as Meibomian glands, the areola as Montgomery tubercles, and oral mucosa as Fordyce spots). Composed of lipid-producing sebocytes that rupture to secrete sebum, an oily mixture of triglycerides, squalene, and wax esters that lubricates and waterproofs the skin and hair while exerting mild antimicrobial prop-

erties; androgen-driven hyperactivity and follicular hyperkeratinization are central to the pathogenesis of acne vulgaris.

Alternate Names:
Sebaceous Glands

Sebaceous Gland Carcinoma

Sebaceous gland carcinoma is an uncommon skin cancer arising from oil glands, often appearing as a firm yellowish eyelid or skin lump.

Sebaceous Glands

Plural form; see *Sebaceous Gland*.

Sebaceous Hyperplasia

A benign enlargement of sebaceous glands, presenting as small yellowish papules with central umbilication, usually on the face of adults.

Seborrhea

A term used inconsistently for oily skin or scalp with greasy scale. It is often used to refer to seborrheic dermatitis, an inflammatory skin condition that commonly affects the scalp, face, and chest.

Seborrheic Dermatitis

A chronic, relapsing inflammatory skin disorder affecting sebum-rich areas, especially the scalp, face, ears, and chest. It produces erythematous patches with greasy white or yellow scale; dandruff is its mild, scalp-limited form.

Seborrheic Keratoses

Plural form; see *Seborrheic Keratosis*.

Seborrheic Keratosis

A common benign epidermal growth with a sharply defined, waxy or verrucous, "stuck-on" surface. Lesions may be flat or raised and range from skin-colored to brown or black; they become more common with age and are not premalignant.

Alternate Names:
Basal Cell Papilloma; Senile Wart

Seborrhoea

British spelling of seborrhea, meaning excessive sebum production; the term is also used loosely for seborrheic dermatitis.

Seborrhoeic

Relating to increased or altered activity of sebaceous glands or to areas rich in these glands, such as the scalp, face, chest, and upper back.

Seborrhoeic Dermatitis

British spelling; see *Seborrheic Dermatitis*.

Seborrhoeic Keratosis

British spelling; see *Seborrheic Keratosis*.

Sebum

An oily substance made by skin glands that lubricates and protects the skin and hair. Excess production can contribute to oily skin, acne, and dandruff, while changes may accompany some skin disorders.

Seckel Syndrome

A rare inherited condition causing severe growth restriction before and after birth, a very small head, characteristic facial features, and often developmental or intellectual disability. Bone, blood, and other birth differences may also occur.

Secobarbital Overdose

Poisoning from taking too much secobarbital, a sedative medicine. It can cause extreme sleepiness, confusion, slowed breathing, coma, or death.

Secondaries In The Liver

Informal name for cancer that has spread to the liver from another part of the body; see *Liver Metastases*.

Secondary Adrenal Insufficiency

Reduced production of adrenal hormones because the pituitary or brain does not provide enough stimulation, often after long-term steroid treatment is stopped suddenly. It can cause fatigue, weakness, nausea, low blood pressure, and low blood sugar;

skin darkening and salt loss are less typical than in primary adrenal failure.

Secondary Amenorrhea

Absence of menstruation for at least three months in someone with previously regular cycles or six months with previously irregular cycles, caused by pregnancy, endocrine, ovarian, uterine, or systemic factors.

Secondary Attack Rate

The proportion of susceptible people who become infected after contact with an initial case during a defined period. It helps estimate how readily an infection spreads in households, schools, healthcare settings, or other close-contact groups.

Secondary Brain Cancer

Alternate name; see *Brain Metastases*.

Secondary Cancer

A cancer that has spread from its original site to another part of the body; the resulting tumor is a metastasis.

Secondary Glaucoma

Glaucoma caused by another eye disease, systemic disease (a condition affecting the body), eye injury, or medicine. The cause may obstruct aqueous outflow or raise intraocular pressure (pressure inside the eye); the drainage angle may be open or closed, and the optic nerve may be damaged.

Secondary Hyperparathyroidism

Overactivity of the parathyroid glands in response to low calcium, abnormal phosphate, vitamin-D deficiency, or kidney disease. It can weaken bones, cause bone pain, and contribute to calcium deposits in blood vessels.

Secondary Hypertension

High blood pressure caused by an identifiable medical condition, medicine, or substance, rather than primary (essential) hypertension. Causes include kidney disease or narrowed kidney arteries, hormone disorders, sleep apnea, pregnancy-related conditions such as preeclampsia, and certain medicines or drugs, including steroids, stimulants, decongestants, and some pain relievers. Treating the cause may improve blood pressure.

Secondary Hypothyroidism

Low thyroid-hormone production because the pituitary or nearby brain area does not provide enough thyroid-stimulating signal. It may cause tiredness, feeling cold, constipation, dry skin, slow heart rate, or menstrual changes.

Secondary Immune Response

A faster and stronger defense when the body meets a germ or foreign substance again. Memory immune cells from the first exposure respond quickly and usually produce antibodies and other defenses more effectively.

Secondary Immunodeficiency

Reduced immune function caused by an acquired condition or exposure rather than a primary genetic disorder. Causes include HIV infection, cancer, malnutrition, medicines, and chronic disease; the manifestations depend on which immune functions are impaired.

Secondary Infections

Infections that develop during or after another disease, injury, or treatment because of tissue damage, altered defenses, or immunosuppression.

Secondary Infertility

Difficulty becoming pregnant or carrying a pregnancy to term after a previous pregnancy. It may affect either or both partners and can have the same causes as infertility in people who have never been pregnant, or be related to changes in health, age, or reproductive function.

Secondary Lymphoid Organs

Organs where mature lymphocytes meet foreign substances and begin immune responses. They include lymph nodes, the spleen, tonsils, and other lymphoid tissues.

Secondary Osteoporosis

Bone loss caused by another illness, medication, or prolonged immobility.

Secondary Osteosarcoma

An osteogenic sarcoma arising in previously abnormal or treated bone, such as bone affected by Paget disease, prior radiation, or chronic bone lesions; prognosis and treatment depend on stage and resectability.

Secondary Parkinsonism

Secondary parkinsonism is slowed movement, rigidity, tremor, or postural instability caused by another condition, medicine, toxin, vascular injury, or structural brain disease.

Secondary Peritonitis

Diffuse or localized acute bacterial or chemical inflammation of the peritoneal cavity resulting from direct breach of an intra-abdominal hollow viscus, such as a perforated peptic ulcer, ruptured appendix, ischemic bowel perforation, or anastomotic leak.

Alternate Names:
Acute Secondary Peritoneal Inflammation

Secondary Polycythemia

An absolute increase in red blood cell mass driven by elevated circulating erythropoietin levels, either as an appropriate physiological response to chronic systemic hypoxia (chronic cyanotic lung/heart disease, high altitude, smoking) or pathologically from erythropoietin-secreting tumors (renal cell carcinoma, cerebellar hemangioblastoma, hepatocellular carcinoma).

Secondary Postpartum Hemorrhage

Heavy or abnormal bleeding occurring more than 24 hours and up to 12 weeks after childbirth. Causes include retained placental tissue, infection, poor healing where the placenta was attached, or a bleeding disorder. Heavy bleeding, dizziness, fainting, fever, or severe pain may occur.

Alternate Names:
Late Postpartum Hemorrhage; Delayed PPH

Secondary Prevention

Finding and treating a disease early to stop it worsening or causing complications. Examples include screening for some cancers, checking blood pressure, testing for early diabetes, and treating an abnormality before it produces serious symptoms.

Secondary Progressive Multiple Sclerosis

A phase of multiple sclerosis in which disability gradually worsens over time after an earlier relapsing pattern. Relapses may still occur, but progressive walking, strength, vision, bladder, thinking, or other problems can develop even between attacks.

Alternate Names:
SPMS; Secondary-Progressive MS

Secondary Psychosis

Psychotic symptoms caused or contributed to by a medical illness, medicine, substance, or neurologic disorder rather than a primary psychotic disorder. New hallucinations, delusions, or confusion can reflect a reversible underlying cause.

Secondary Sexual Characteristics

Physical changes that develop during puberty and are not directly part of the reproductive organs, such as breast development, facial or body hair, voice changes, and changes in body shape.

Secondary Shock

Circulatory failure occurring as a consequence of another condition, such as infection, trauma, bleeding, heart failure, allergy, or endocrine crisis, with inadequate tissue perfusion.

Secondary Syphilis

The stage of syphilis that occurs weeks or months after the first sore when the bacteria spread through the body. It may cause a widespread rash, including the palms and soles, swollen glands, fever, tiredness, mouth patches, or moist lesions; antibiotic treatment can cure the infection.

Secondary Systemic Amyloidosis

Alternate name; see *AA Amyloidosis*.

Secondary Tumor

A tumor formed when cancer cells spread from the original site to another part of the body.

Second-Degree AV Block

A heart-rhythm problem in which some electrical signals from the upper chambers fail to reach the lower chambers. The heartbeat may be slow or irregular; certain patterns can progress to complete heart block.

Second-Degree Burn

A burn that damages the outer skin and part of the layer beneath it. The area is usually painful, red, moist, and blistered; deeper burns may look pale and heal slowly. Large, deep, or sensitive-area burns can cause serious tissue damage.

Second-Hand Smoke

Smoke inhaled from burning tobacco products or exhaled by a person who is smoking. It contains toxic substances and increases health risks in exposed people.

Second-Look Surgery

Second-look surgery is a planned or follow-up operation performed to inspect healing, remove remaining disease, assess treatment response, or manage complications.

Second Malignancy

A new, separate cancer that develops after an earlier cancer. The risk may be influenced by inherited factors, previous radiation or chemotherapy, age, and other exposures; it is different from recurrence of the first cancer.

Second Messengers

Small molecules inside cells that pass along messages received from hormones, nerve chemicals, or other outside signals. They help control contraction, secretion, metabolism, gene activity, and cell growth.

Second Messenger Systems

Internal signaling systems that carry a message from a hormone, nerve chemical, or growth factor at the cell surface to processes inside the cell. They can change contraction, secretion, metabolism, gene activity, or cell growth.

Second Opinion

An independent medical assessment by another qualified clinician to help confirm or clarify a diagnosis, prognosis, or treatment plan.

Second Stage of Labor

The part of childbirth that begins when the cervix is fully open and ends when the baby is born. It includes descent of the baby and pushing; its length varies with previous births, pain relief, the baby's position, and the health of parent and baby.

Second Trimester

The middle part of pregnancy, from 14 through 27 completed weeks. The fetus grows rapidly, movement is often felt, and ultrasound and blood screening may assess development and certain conditions; the timing and tests vary by pregnancy and local care.

Secretin

A hormone released by the first part of the small intestine when acidic stomach contents enter it. Secretin prompts the pancreas and bile ducts to release alkaline fluid, helping neutralize acid and support digestion.

Secretin Stimulation Test

A test in which secretin is given and changes in blood or digestive fluid are measured. It may assess pancreatic function or investigate a rare tumor that releases excess gastrin and stomach acid.

Secretion

The release of a substance from cells or glands into the blood, a body passage, or outside the body. Examples include saliva, hormones, digestive juices, mucus, and substances removed into urine or bile.

Secretory Diarrhea

Watery diarrhea caused when the intestine releases too much water and salt or absorbs too little. It may continue even without eating and can result from infection, medicines, bile-acid problems, hormone-producing tumors, or inflammation.

Section

A defined part or subdivision of an organ, document, study, or procedure; in anatomy and imaging, the term identifies a specific slice or region examined.

Sedation

The use of medicines to make a person relaxed, drowsy, or less aware during a procedure while maintaining appropriate monitoring and breathing.

Sedation Dentistry

The use of medicine during dental care to reduce fear, discomfort, or awareness. It may involve inhaled gas, tablets, or medicines through a vein; deeper sedation can affect breathing and requires trained staff and continuous monitoring.

Sedation Levels

The depth of medicine-induced drowsiness, ranging from minimal relaxation with normal responses to deep sedation with limited response and possible breathing or airway support. Sedation can deepen unexpectedly, so appropriate monitoring is required.

Sedative

A chemical agent or medication that depresses the central nervous system to reduce excitement, irritability, or anxiety, producing a calming, tranquilizing effect (anxiolysis) at lower doses and drowsiness or sleep induction (hypnosis) at higher doses. Major pharmacologic classes include benzodiazepines, non-benzodiazepine receptor agonists (Z-drugs), barbiturates, and central alpha-2 agonists; risks include cognitive and motor impairment, respiratory depression, physiological tolerance, dependence, and life-threatening withdrawal upon abrupt discontinuation.

Alternate Names:
Sedatives; Sedative-Hypnotic; Sedative-Hypnotics

Sedative-Hypnotic

A medicine or substance that slows brain activity to reduce anxiety or cause sleep. Examples include benzodiazepines, barbiturates, and some sleep medicines. Too much can cause confusion, coma, or dangerously slow breathing, especially with alcohol or opioids.

Sedative, Hypnotic, or Anxiolytic Use Disorder

A pattern of problematic use of sedative, hypnotic, or anxiolytic medicines causing impairment, distress, tolerance, withdrawal, or inability to control use.

Sedative-Hypnotic Toxidrome

A pattern of poisoning caused by substances that slow brain activity. It may cause extreme sleepiness, slurred speech, poor coordination, slow breathing, coma, or loss of airway protection, especially when combined with alcohol or opioids.

Sedatives

Plural form; see *Sedative*.

Sedimentation Rate

The erythrocyte sedimentation rate, a nonspecific blood test measuring how quickly red cells settle in a tube and sometimes supporting assessment of inflammation when interpreted with other findings.

Sed Rate

A blood test measuring how quickly red blood cells settle, used as a nonspecific marker of inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Erythrocyte Sedimentation Rate; ESR

Segmental Innervation

The organization of nerve supply according to spinal cord segments. Each segment contributes to characteristic dermatomes, myotomes, and reflexes, so changes in sensation, strength, or reflexes can help localize a neurologic lesion.

Segmental Pressures

Blood-pressure readings taken at several points on

the arms and legs to compare circulation. A large difference between levels can help locate a narrowed or blocked artery in peripheral artery disease.

Segmentation

Repeated squeezing of short sections of the intestine that mixes food with digestive fluids and brings it against the intestinal lining for absorption. Unlike peristalsis, it mainly mixes contents rather than pushing them forward.

Segmentectomy

Surgery removing one or more defined sections of a lung rather than an entire lobe. It may treat a small, localized lung cancer or another focal problem while preserving more lung tissue; bleeding, air leakage, infection, and reduced breathing capacity are possible.

Alternate Names:
Anatomical Segmentectomy; Pulmonary Segmentectomy

SEID

Alternate name; see *Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome*.

Seidel Test

An eye examination using fluorescein dye to look for leaking fluid from a full-thickness injury to the cornea or eye wall. Streaming or dilution of the dye suggests a leak, but a negative test does not rule out a serious eye injury.

Alternate Names:
Seidel's Test; Aqueous Humor Leakage Test

Seizure

A transient episode of signs or symptoms caused by abnormal excessive or synchronous electrical activity in the brain. It may affect movement, sensation, awareness, behavior, or autonomic function; some seizures cause convulsions, while others do not. Seizures may be provoked by illness or injury or occur in epilepsy; one seizure alone does not establish epilepsy.

Alternate Names:
Seizures

Seizure Disorder

A chronic neurologic condition characterized by an enduring predisposition to generate recurrent unprovoked epileptic seizures, encompassing epilepsy and its associated neurobiological, cognitive, and psychosocial consequences. Seizures are classified by onset into focal, generalized, and unknown onset; clinical evaluation involves electroencephalography (EEG) and brain MRI to identify epileptogenic foci, structural lesions, or genetic channelopathies. Management utilizes targeted anti-seizure medications, ketogenic diet, vagus nerve stimulation, or epilepsy resective surgery.

Alternate Names:
Seizure Disorders; Epilepsy

Seizure Disorders

Plural form; see *Seizure Disorder*.

Seizure Disorders in Pregnancy

Epilepsy and new-onset seizures during pregnancy. Causes include pre-existing epilepsy, metabolic problems, medicine effects, and eclampsia; antiseizure medicines can affect fetal development, while uncontrolled seizures can harm the pregnant person and fetus.

Selective Antibody Deficiency With Normal Immunoglobulins

An immune problem in which the total amount of antibodies is normal but the body does not make enough protective antibodies against some germs after vaccination. Repeated ear, sinus, or chest infections may occur.

Selective Deficiency Of IgA

A usually inherited immune problem in which the antibody IgA is very low or absent while other antibodies are near normal. Some people have repeated sinus, chest, or bowel infections, allergies, or autoimmune disease; others have no symptoms.

Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulator

A class of medications that interact with the body's estrogen receptors in a targeted, tissue-specific manner, behaving like estrogen in some body tissues

while blocking estrogen's effects in others. For example, some SERMs block estrogen in breast tissue to help prevent or treat hormone-sensitive breast cancers, while acting like estrogen in bone tissue to help protect bone strength and prevent osteoporosis.

Alternate Names:
Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulators; SERM; SERMs

Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulators

Plural form; see *Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulator*.

Selective IgA Deficiency

An immune condition with very low or absent immunoglobulin A, an antibody protecting mucus-lined surfaces. Some people have repeated respiratory or intestinal infections, allergies, autoimmune disease, or no symptoms.

Selective Mutism

A childhood anxiety disorder in which a person speaks comfortably in some settings but repeatedly cannot speak in others, such as school or unfamiliar social situations. It lasts at least one month and can interfere with learning, relationships, or daily life.

Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors

Antidepressants that increase serotonin signaling by slowing its reabsorption by nerve cells. They treat depression and several anxiety disorders, but effects take time and may include nausea, sexual problems, sleep changes, or withdrawal symptoms.

Alternate Names:
SSRIs

Selective Serotonin-Reuptake Inhibitors

Antidepressants that increase the availability of serotonin, a chemical used for communication between nerve cells. They treat depression and anxiety disorders; nausea, sleep changes, sexual problems, and withdrawal symptoms can occur.

Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor (SSRI)

Alternate name; see *Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors*.

Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor Toxicity

Harm from taking too much of a selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor or combining it with interacting substances. Effects may include nausea, tremor, drowsiness, or agitation; severe cases can cause serotonin syndrome, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, or death.

Selective Tubal Occlusion Procedure

Selective tubal occlusion blocks a fallopian tube to prevent sperm and egg from meeting and is a permanent contraceptive procedure.

Selegiline

A medicine that blocks monoamine oxidase B, used for Parkinson disease and sometimes depression; interactions require caution.

Selenium

A mineral needed for antioxidant enzymes, thyroid function, reproduction, and immune activity. Deficiency is uncommon in many regions, while excessive supplements can cause hair or nail changes, stomach upset, nerve problems, or toxicity.

Selenium-75

A radioactive form of selenium used mainly as a calibration or testing source in imaging and measurement equipment. It releases radiation as it decays and has a half-life of about 120 days.

Selenium Deficiency

Low levels of selenium, a trace element needed for antioxidant enzymes and thyroid hormone activity. It is uncommon in most regions and usually subclinical, but severe deficiency contributes to Keshan disease, affecting heart muscle, and Kashin-Beck disease in selenium-poor areas. Assessment and replacement are guided by clinical and laboratory findings.

Selenium In Diet

Selenium is a trace mineral needed for antioxidant enzymes, thyroid hormone metabolism, and reproduction. Excess intake, especially from supplements, can cause toxicity.

Selenium Sulphide

A skin-applied medicine that reduces certain fungi and excess scaling. It is used for dandruff and seborrheic dermatitis and may cause irritation, dryness, discoloration, or an unpleasant smell if misused.

Self-Diagnosing Body Dysmorphic Disorder

Alternate name; see *Body Dysmorphic Disorder*.

Self-Diagnosis

Identification of a health problem by a person without formal clinical assessment. It may be inaccurate because symptoms can have multiple causes.

Self-Efficacy

A person's confidence in their ability to manage a health condition, follow a treatment plan, and handle symptoms. It can influence participation in care and health outcomes.

Self-Harm

Intentional self-injury or self-poisoning, regardless of whether the person intends to die. It includes acts such as cutting, burning, hitting oneself, or taking an overdose; suicidal intent should be described separately when known.

Self Harming

Alternate name; see *Self-Injury/Cutting*.

Self-Help Group

A peer group in which members support one another while changing a harmful behavior or coping with a problem.

Alternate Names:
Support Group; Peer Support Group

Self-Injury/Cutting

Deliberate injury to one's own body, often used to cope with overwhelming emotions and requiring compassionate assessment of safety and mental health.

Alternate Names:
Nonsuicidal Self-Injury; NSSI

Self-Management

Actions a person takes to monitor and manage a health condition, including treatment use, symptom monitoring, and lifestyle measures.

Self-Poisoning

Intentional ingestion or exposure to a potentially harmful substance, which may be associated with suicidal intent and can cause poisoning or injury.

Self-Retaining Retraction

Holding tissue away from an operative field with a retractor that remains in position without continuous manual support.

Alternate Names:
Self-Retaining Retraction; Mechanical Retraction

Self-Testing For COVID-19

Testing a sample collected at home, usually from the nose, to check for COVID-19 infection. A negative result does not always rule out infection, especially early in illness.

Sella Turcica

A saddle-shaped hollow in a bone at the base of the skull that holds the pituitary gland. The pituitary controls many hormones, so changes in this area can affect growth, reproduction, metabolism, and the body's response to stress.

Semaglutide

Semaglutide is a glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonist used for selected patients with type 2 diabetes or chronic weight management. It slows gastric emptying and reduces appetite and glucose levels; nausea, gallbladder disease, pancreatitis risk, and contraindications require review.

Semen

The fluid released during ejaculation, containing sperm from the testes mixed with fluids from the seminal vesicles, prostate, and other glands. It carries and supports sperm; changes in amount, color, or the presence of blood or pain may reflect reproductive or urinary conditions.

Semen Analysis

A laboratory examination measuring semen volume and sperm number, movement, shape, and vitality. It is a common first test when assessing fertility; results vary, so an abnormal result is often repeated and interpreted with the couple's history.

Semen DNA Analysis

A test that examines genetic material inside sperm, usually for selected infertility or repeated-pregnancy-loss evaluations. It may detect increased DNA damage, but its usefulness and treatment implications depend on the clinical situation.

Semicircular Canals

Three curved, fluid-filled tubes in each inner ear that sense head rotation and help maintain balance. Problems affecting them can cause spinning dizziness, nausea, or difficulty keeping the eyes steady when the head moves.

Semi-Fowler Position

A bed position in which a person lies on the back with the head of the bed raised, often about 30 to 45 degrees from horizontal. It is less upright than Fowler position. The angle ranges can overlap at about 45 degrees.

Semilunar Cartilages

The two crescent-shaped pads of tough cartilage inside the knee, commonly called the menisci. They cushion the joint, spread weight, and improve stability; a tear can cause pain, swelling, catching, or locking.

Semilunar Valves

The aortic and pulmonary valves, which open during ventricular contraction and close during ventricular relaxation to prevent backflow into the ventricles.

Seminal Fluid Analysis

A laboratory test of semen that measures the amount of fluid and the number, movement, and shape of sperm. It helps assess fertility and may check whether sperm remain after a vasectomy.

Alternate Names:
Semen Analysis; Spermiogram

Seminal Vesicle

One of a pair of convoluted, tubular glands situated posterior to the urinary bladder and lateral to the ampullae of the ductus deferens in males. The seminal vesicles synthesize and secrete a thick, alkaline fluid that constitutes approximately 65–75% of total ejaculate volume, enriched with fructose (serving as an energy source for sperm motility), prostaglandins (stimulating uterine contractions), semenogelin (coagulating seminal fluid), and vitamin C. The excretory duct merges with the vas deferens to form the ejaculatory duct emptying into the prostatic urethra.

Alternate Names:
Seminal Vesicles; Vesicula Seminalis

Seminal Vesicles

Plural form; see *Seminal Vesicle*.

Seminiferous Tubules

Tiny, coiled tubes inside the testes where sperm are made. Supporting cells nourish developing sperm and help create the environment needed for sperm production.

Seminoma

A cancerous tumor arising from sperm-forming cells in the testis. It often grows slowly and is highly treatable with surgery, radiation, chemotherapy, or careful monitoring depending on its stage.

Semont Maneuver

A rapid, side-to-side liberatory repositioning maneuver used in the clinical management of posterior semicircular canal benign paroxysmal positional ver-

tigo (BPPV), designed to dislodge cupulolithiasis or canalithiasis debris into the utricle.

Alternate Names:
Semont Liberatory Maneuver; Liberatory Maneuver for BPPV

Senescence

Changes and gradual loss of function associated with aging. In cells, senescence is a lasting state in which a cell stops dividing but remains active; an accumulation of such cells may contribute to aging and disease.

Alternate Names:
Biological aging

Senile Lentigines

Flat, sharply defined brown or tan spots caused by chronic ultraviolet exposure, commonly appearing on sun-exposed skin with age.

Senile Purpura

Alternate name; see *Actinic Purpura*.

Senna

A plant-derived stimulant laxative containing sennosides, used short term for constipation and sometimes to empty the bowel before a procedure. It increases intestinal activity and may cause abdominal cramps or diarrhea; prolonged or excessive use can cause dependence or fluid and electrolyte disturbances.

Sensate Focus Techniques

Structured, gradual touch exercises used in sex therapy to reduce performance pressure, improve body awareness, and rebuild comfortable intimacy. Partners agree on boundaries and initially avoid goals such as intercourse or orgasm.

Alternate Names:
Sensate Focus; Masters and Johnson Therapy

Sensation

Awareness of changes such as touch, pain, temperature, sound, movement, or body position. Special nerve endings detect these changes and send messages to the brain, where they are experienced and interpreted.

Sense

A sense is a capacity to detect and interpret stimuli such as touch, temperature, pain, sound, light, smell, taste, position, or internal body signals.

Sensitisation

A process in which repeated exposure makes the body's immune, nerve, or behavioral response stronger or easier to trigger. Sensitization can contribute to allergy, chronic pain, and some learned responses.

Sensitivity

In testing, the proportion of people who truly have a condition and receive a positive result. In other settings, it means how strongly a person, cell, or instrument responds to a stimulus.

Sensitivity Analysis

Sensitivity analysis tests how much a study's conclusion changes when assumptions, measurements, or input values are varied.

Sensitized

Having antibodies against human-cell markers called HLA. This can happen after pregnancy, transfusion, or transplantation and may make it harder to find a suitable organ donor or increase the risk of transplant rejection.

Sensorimotor Polyneuropathy

Damage to many nerves causing both altered sensation and weakness, usually starting in the feet or hands. Numbness, burning pain, poor balance, reduced reflexes, and muscle wasting may occur; diabetes is one possible cause.

Sensorineural Deafness

Sensorineural deafness is hearing loss from dysfunction of the inner ear, auditory nerve, or central pathways rather than blockage of sound conduction.

Sensorineural Hearing Loss

Hearing loss caused by damage to the inner ear or the nerve that carries sound to the brain. It can make speech hard to understand, especially in noisy places, and may result from aging, loud noise, infection, inherited conditions, or medicines.

Sensorium

A person's level of consciousness, awareness, attention, and understanding of surroundings. Changes may include confusion, drowsiness, agitation, disorientation, or reduced responsiveness and can signal illness, medicines, intoxication, or brain injury.

Sensory

Relating to sensation or to nerves and pathways that carry information such as touch, pain, temperature, position, hearing, or vision to the brain.

Sensory Cortex

Areas of the brain that receive and interpret information about touch, pain, temperature, pressure, and body position. Damage can cause numbness, altered sensation, or difficulty recognizing where a body part is.

Sensory Deprivation

A major reduction in normal input from sight, sound, touch, movement, or other senses. Prolonged deprivation can affect mood, thinking, sleep, orientation, and perception, especially in isolated or vulnerable people.

Sensory Level

A clear line on the body below which feeling is reduced or changed. It can suggest a spinal-cord problem, especially when accompanied by weakness, altered reflexes, or bladder and bowel problems.

Sensory Nerves

Nerves that carry information such as touch, pain, temperature, and position from the body to the spinal cord and brain. Damage may cause numbness, tingling, burning pain, or reduced awareness of injury.

Sensory Neuron

A nerve cell that carries information from receptors toward the brain and spinal cord. It helps detect touch, pain, temperature, pressure, body position, sound, light, smell, and taste.

Sensory Processing Disorder

Difficulty noticing, interpreting, or responding to sound, touch, movement, light, or body position. It may affect behavior, learning, coordination, or daily activities and can occur with other developmental conditions; assessment and support are individualized.

Sensory Receptors

Specialized cells or nerve endings that detect stimuli such as touch, temperature, pain, light, sound, or chemical changes.

Sentinel Event

An unexpected healthcare event that causes death or serious physical or psychological harm, or creates a major risk of such harm. It is associated with formal review and system-level safety changes.

Sentinel Injury

An unexpected injury in an infant who cannot yet move independently, such as bruising, a mouth injury, or a fracture. It may be an early sign of inflicted injury or other serious harm.

Sentinel Loop

A localized, persistently gas-filled, dilated segment of small intestine visible on plain abdominal radiographs, reflecting focal paralytic ileus produced by adjacent acute intraperitoneal inflammation (most commonly acute pancreatitis or acute appendicitis).

Alternate Names:
Sentinel Loop Sign; Localized Adynamic Ileus

Sentinel Lymph Node

The first lymph node or group of nodes most likely to receive fluid draining from a tumor. Removing and examining them can show whether cancer has begun to spread and help determine its stage.

Sentinel Lymph-Node Biopsy

Surgical removal and pathologic examination of the first draining lymph node or nodes from a primary tumor. It is used for selected melanomas, breast cancers, and other tumors to assess regional metastatic risk and guide staging.

Sentinel Lymph Node Biopsy For Melanoma

Sentinel lymph-node biopsy identifies and removes the first draining lymph node or nodes from a melanoma site to detect microscopic spread. The result helps stage disease and guide further treatment; it does not remove all regional nodes routinely.

Sentinel Node

A sentinel node is the first lymph node or group of nodes to which cancer cells are most likely to spread from a primary tumor. A sentinel lymph-node biopsy helps assess spread.

Sentinel Node Biopsy

Alternate name; see *Sentinel Lymph-Node Biopsy*.

Sentinel Surveillance

Ongoing collection of health information from selected clinics, laboratories, or communities to track disease trends. It can provide early warning of outbreaks but does not count every case in the population.

Separated Cranial Sutures

Separated cranial sutures in an infant can reflect normal growth or increased intracranial pressure, hydrocephalus, prematurity, or other illness and require clinical assessment.

Separation Anxiety

Separation anxiety is developmentally excessive fear or distress when apart from an attachment figure, causing avoidance, physical complaints, sleep problems, or impairment. Treatment may include gradual exposure, family-based support, cognitive behavioral therapy, and selected medication.

Separation Anxiety Disorder

Excessive and persistent fear about being apart from a parent, partner, or other attachment figure. It may cause repeated reassurance-seeking, refusal to leave home, nightmares, physical symptoms, or difficulty attending school or work.

Separation Anxiety In Children

Developmentally excessive distress when separated from an attachment figure, with worry, refusal, physical symptoms, nightmares, or school avoidance that impairs daily life.

Separation Of The Iris

A tear that pulls the colored part of the eye away from its normal attachment, usually after a blunt injury. It may cause double vision, glare, an irregular pupil, bleeding, or increased eye pressure and needs eye-specialist assessment.

Sepsis

A life-threatening medical emergency caused by the body's overwhelming and toxic response to an infection. Instead of remaining localized to fight off the invading bacteria, viruses, or fungi, the immune system releases immune chemicals into the bloodstream that trigger widespread inflammation. This systemic response damages healthy blood vessels and organs, leading to dangerously low blood pressure, poor blood circulation, and progressive failure of vital organs such as the kidneys, lungs, and heart.

Alternate Names:
Systemic Inflammatory Response to Infection; Blood Poisoning

Sepsis Syndrome

An older, nonspecific term for a severe response to infection. Current medical usage favors *sepsis* when infection causes life-threatening organ dysfunction and *septic shock* when circulatory and metabolic abnormalities persist despite fluid treatment.

Septal Defect

An abnormal opening in the septum between the heart's chambers that permits blood to pass between the right and left sides of the heart.

Septal Hematoma

A collection of blood inside the wall dividing the two sides of the nose, usually after an injury. It causes blockage and painful swelling and can destroy cartilage and deform the nose if untreated.

Septate Uterus

A congenital difference in which a band of tissue partly or completely divides the inside of the uterus. Many people have no symptoms, but it can increase miscarriage or some pregnancy risks; imaging confirms it, and selected cases are treated by removing the dividing tissue.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Septum

Septic

Relating to a serious infection or to harmful germs in a normally sterile body site. For example, septic arthritis is an infected joint, while septic shock is life-threatening organ and circulation failure caused by an overwhelming infection.

Septic Abortion

A miscarriage or induced pregnancy loss complicated by infection of the uterus or surrounding tissues. Fever, chills, worsening abdominal pain, foul discharge, fast heartbeat, or faintness may occur; it is an emergency requiring antibiotics, supportive care, and removal of infected retained tissue when necessary.

Alternate Names:
Infected Abortion

Septicaemia

Older term; see *Bacteremia* or *Sepsis*, depending on the clinical findings.

Septic Arthritis

Infection of a joint, usually bacterial, causing acute pain, swelling, restricted movement, and systemic illness.

Alternate Names:
Pyogenic Arthritis; Bacterial Arthritis

Septic Embolism

A piece of infected material travels through the bloodstream and blocks a smaller blood vessel, spreading infection to another organ. It often starts with an infected heart valve and can cause abscesses or tissue damage.

Septicemia

Older term; see *Bacteremia* or *Sepsis*, depending on the clinical findings.

Septic Pulmonary Infarction

Death of part of the lung after infected clots or other infected material block small lung arteries. It may cause fever, chest pain worse with breathing, cough, coughing blood, and lung abscesses.

Septic Shock

The most severe and life-threatening stage of sepsis, occurring when an overwhelming bodily response to infection causes a catastrophic drop in blood pressure that cannot be restored with intravenous fluids alone. The profound failure of the circulatory system deprives vital organs of oxygen and blood flow, resulting in severe tissue damage, multi-organ failure, and a very high risk of death.

Septic Shock Criteria

Clinical diagnostic criteria defined by consensus Sepsis-3 guidelines: persistent sepsis-induced hypotension requiring vasopressor therapy to maintain a mean arterial pressure of at least 65 mmHg, accompanied by a serum lactate level exceeding 2 mmol/L despite adequate fluid resuscitation.

Septic Thrombophlebitis

Infected thrombosis within a vein, causing local inflammation and possible bloodstream infection or septic emboli. It may complicate intravenous devices, pelvic infection, skin infection, or deep soft-tissue infection.

Septo-Optic Dysplasia

A condition present from birth involving underdevelopment of one or both optic nerves, parts of the brain's midline, and sometimes the pituitary

gland. It may cause poor vision, involuntary eye movements, seizures, developmental differences, or hormone deficiencies.

Septoplasty

Septoplasty is surgery to straighten or reshape the nasal septum to improve airflow or address structural obstruction.

Septum

A wall or partition separating two spaces or tissues, such as the nasal septum or the septum between heart chambers.

Severe Sepsis

Older term from pre-2016 definitions for SIRS caused by suspected or documented infection, with organ dysfunction, poor tissue blood flow, or low blood pressure. The current Sepsis-3 definition includes life-threatening infection-related organ dysfunction under *Sepsis*, so it considers "severe sepsis" redundant.

Sequela

A lasting consequence or condition that remains after an earlier disease, injury, infection, or treatment has ended, such as paralysis after stroke or scarring after infection.

Sequelae

Lasting effects or complications that remain after an illness or injury. Examples include weakness after a stroke, breathing problems after severe infection, or pain after an injury; sequelae may be physical, mental, emotional, or social.

Sequential Therapy

Treatment in which different medicines or interventions are given one after another rather than at the same time. The sequence may improve safety, effectiveness, or tolerance.

Sequester

To sequester means to isolate or set apart; in medicine, sequestered tissue or material is separated from its normal circulation or surroundings.

Sequestrum

A piece of dead bone that has separated from healthy bone, usually because of a long-lasting bone infection. It can prevent healing, cause drainage or pain, and may need surgery after infection is treated.

Ser

Ser is the standard abbreviation for serine, an amino acid incorporated into proteins and involved in metabolism and cell signaling.

Serine

Serine is a nonessential amino acid used in protein synthesis, one-carbon metabolism, membrane formation, and signaling.

Serious Adverse Event

An unwanted medical event that results in death, is life-threatening, requires or prolongs hospitalization, causes major disability, or causes a birth defect. It may occur during treatment without being caused by the treatment.

Serious Health Problems Symptoms

Critical clinical signs and red-flag symptoms signaling potentially life-threatening or emergent medical disorders requiring urgent medical evaluation. Examples include sudden severe (thunderclap) headache, acute unilateral weakness or facial droop, crushing retrosternal chest pain, acute respiratory distress, hemoptysis, hematemesis, high fever accompanied by nuchal rigidity, and sudden loss of consciousness.

Alternate Names:
Red Flag Symptoms; Emergency Warning Signs

SERMs

Selective estrogen receptor modulators that have estrogen-like effects in some tissues and blocking effects in others.

Alternate Names:
Selective Estrogen Receptor Modulators

Seroconversion

Development of detectable antibodies in blood after infection, vaccination, or another immune-triggering event, showing a changed immune status.

Serodiagnostic

Relating to diagnosis using antibodies, antigens, or other markers measured in blood serum. These tests can show infection, immunity, inflammation, or other conditions; results vary with timing and clinical context.

Serologic Test

A blood test that detects antibodies, antigens, or other immune markers to help diagnose infection, assess immunity, or monitor response to treatment.

Serology

The laboratory evaluation of serum for antibodies, antigens, or other immune markers. Results may indicate current infection, previous exposure, vaccination, autoimmune reactivity, or passive antibody transfer and must be interpreted with timing and clinical context.

Serology For Brucellosis

Blood testing for antibodies to Brucella species, interpreted with exposure history and symptoms because cross-reactions and early false-negative results can occur.

Seroma

A pocket of clear body fluid that forms near a surgical incision or injured tissue. It may cause swelling, pressure, or discomfort and often resolves, though large or painful collections may need drainage.

Seronegative Arthritis

Inflammatory arthritis in which common blood tests for rheumatoid factor and anti-CCP antibodies are negative. It includes several diseases with different patterns, such as spine, skin, bowel, or eye involvement, so symptoms and examination guide diagnosis.

Serosanguineous

Containing both serous fluid and a small amount of blood. It often describes thin wound drainage that looks pink or light red, though the color can vary with the amount of blood. It differs from sanguineous drainage, which consists mainly of fresh blood.

Serositis

Inflammation of the smooth lining around the lungs, heart, or abdominal organs. It can cause sharp pain that worsens with breathing or movement and may cause fluid to collect around the affected organ.

Serotonin

A chemical messenger used by nerve cells and other tissues. It helps regulate mood, sleep, appetite, bowel function, and pain; too much activity from medicines can cause serotonin syndrome.

Alternate Names:
5-Hydroxytryptamine; 5-HT

Serotonin Blood Test

A blood test measuring serotonin, used selectively in evaluating suspected serotonin-producing neuroendocrine tumors; many medicines and specimen factors affect results.

Serotonin-Norepinephrine Reuptake Inhibitors

Antidepressants that increase the activity of serotonin and norepinephrine, chemical messengers between nerve cells. They treat depression, some anxiety disorders, and certain nerve or long-lasting pain conditions; nausea, sweating, sleep changes, and withdrawal symptoms can occur.

Serotonin Syndrome

A potentially life-threatening reaction to medicines or drugs that raise serotonin activity. It can occur after combining serotonergic medicines, increasing a dose, or taking too much; it often begins within hours. Symptoms may include restlessness or confusion, sweating, fever, diarrhea, a fast heartbeat, changing blood pressure, tremor, overactive reflexes, or repeated muscle jerks. Severe cases can cause

seizures or organ damage.

Serotype

A subgroup within a microorganism species, distinguished by differences in surface antigens detected through antibody-based tests. Different serotypes may differ in their ability to cause disease or in which vaccines protect against them.

Serous

Describes a thin, watery fluid that is usually clear or pale yellow. A small amount normally lubricates the pleural, pericardial, and peritoneal cavities; similar fluid may drain from a wound or collect in a blister.

Serous Borderline Ovarian Tumor

A low-malignant-potential ovarian tumor whose cells show abnormal growth but lack destructive invasion into supporting tissue. It may remain in the ovary or involve nearby surfaces; treatment and follow-up depend on its extent and microscopic features.

Serous Cystadenoma of Pancreas

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Cysts*.

Serous Fluid Cytology

Examination of cells in fluid collected from around the lungs, heart, or abdominal organs. It can look for cancer cells, infection, or inflammation; additional tests may be needed when the result is unclear.

Serous Membrane

A thin mesothelial membrane that lines the closed internal cavities of the body (the pleural cavities, pericardial cavity, and peritoneal cavity) and reflects over the contained visceral organs. Composed of a single layer of simple squamous mesothelial cells supported by a thin layer of loose connective tissue, it continuously secretes a small amount of lubricative, protein-poor serous fluid that minimizes friction between opposing parietal and visceral surfaces during organ motion (respiration, cardiac contraction, peristalsis).

Alternate Names:
Serous Membranes; Serosa

Serous Membranes

Plural form; see *Serous Membrane*.

Serous Tubal Intraepithelial Carcinoma

An early, noninvasive cancerous change in cells at the end of a fallopian tube near the ovary. It is thought to be the starting point for many high-grade cancers of the ovary, tube, or abdominal lining.

Serpentine Supravenous Hyperpigmentation

A pattern of dark, wavy skin discoloration that follows the paths of surface veins, usually on the upper chest or neck. It can occur with vein inflammation, poor blood flow, some medicines, or cancer.

Serrated Pathway

One route by which some colon cancers develop from flat or saw-toothed polyps. These polyps may be easy to miss during colonoscopy and can acquire cell changes that increase cancer risk, so removal and follow-up are important.

Serrated Polyposis Syndrome

A disorder characterized by multiple serrated lesions or polyps in the colon and an increased risk of colorectal cancer, requiring colonoscopic surveillance and removal of significant lesions.

Serration

A row of small tooth-like projections or notches along an edge, used to describe anatomy, cells, instruments, or imaging appearances.

Serratus Anterior Muscle

A muscle along the side of the chest that holds the shoulder blade against the ribs and helps raise the arm. Injury to its nerve can make the shoulder blade stick out and weaken pushing or overhead movements.

Sertoli Cell

An elongated, somatic “nurse” cell located within the seminiferous tubules of the testes that provides physical, nutritional, and biochemical sup-

port for developing spermatogenic cells throughout spermatogenesis. Regulated by follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) and testosterone, Sertoli cells form tight junctions with adjacent Sertoli cells to establish the blood-testis barrier (isolating haploid germ cells from systemic immune surveillance), phagocytose residual spermatid cytoplasm, and secrete androgen-binding protein (ABP), inhibin B, and anti-Müllerian hormone (AMH) during male embryogenesis.

Alternate Names:
Sertoli Cells; Sustentacular Cell

Sertoli Cells

Plural form; see *Sertoli Cell*.

Sertoli-Cell Tumor

A tumor arising from Sertoli cells, which support sperm development in the testicle. It is often benign but may produce estrogen or other hormones and cause breast enlargement, infertility, or a testicular mass.

Sertoli-Leydig Cell Tumor

A rare ovarian tumor that may produce male hormones, causing increased facial hair, acne, a deeper voice, or irregular periods. Treatment depends on the tumor's stage and features.

Sertoli-Leydig Tumor

Alternate form; see *Sertoli-Leydig Cell Tumor*.

Serum

The clear liquid left after blood has clotted. It contains water, salts, hormones, antibodies, nutrients, and waste products but lacks fibrinogen and most clotting proteins, making it useful for laboratory tests.

Serum Albumin Test

A blood test that measures albumin, a protein made mainly by the liver. A low result can occur with inflammation, liver disease, kidney or intestinal protein loss, or fluid shifts; it is not a stand-alone measure of nutritional status.

Alternate Names:
Serum Albumin Test; Blood Albumin Test; Albumin Level; Serum Albumin Assay

Serum Chloride Test

A clinical laboratory measurement of chloride (Cl^-) concentration in serum or plasma, essential for calculating the serum anion gap and evaluating acid-base balance, hydration status, and renal tubular function.

Alternate Names:
Serum Chloride; Blood Chloride Test; Serum Electrolytes Chloride

Serum Electrolyte Test

A blood test panel that measures the primary circulating electrolytes—sodium, potassium, chloride, and bicarbonate; see *Electrolyte Panel*.

Serum Concentration

The amount of a substance measured in the liquid part of clotted blood. Results may reflect when the sample was taken, how the substance is absorbed and removed, and whether the level is expected to help or harm.

Serum Free Hemoglobin Test

A blood test measuring hemoglobin not contained within red cells, used to support evaluation of intravascular hemolysis, transfusion reactions, or mechanical red-cell destruction.

Serum Glutamic Oxaloacetic Transaminase

SGOT, now called AST, is an enzyme released by injured liver, heart, skeletal muscle, or other cells; an elevated level is not specific to liver injury.

Serum Glutamic Pyruvic Transaminase

SGPT, now called ALT, is an enzyme concentrated in liver cells and commonly measured as a marker of hepatocellular injury.

Serum Herpes Simplex Antibodies

A blood test that detects type-specific IgG antibod-

ies to herpes simplex virus types 1 or 2. HSV-1 antibodies do not show whether infection is oral or genital; HSV-2 antibodies usually indicate anogenital infection. IgM testing is not clinically useful, and blood tests do not confirm that a current lesion is caused by herpes.

Serum Iron Test

A blood test measuring circulating iron bound mainly to transferrin; it is interpreted with ferritin, transferrin saturation, and blood counts rather than used alone to diagnose iron deficiency.

Serum Osmolal Gap

The difference between the measured concentration of dissolved particles in blood and the calculated value. A high gap may suggest an unmeasured substance, including a toxic alcohol, but other illnesses and laboratory factors can also affect it.

Serum Osmolality Test

A laboratory test measuring the total concentration of dissolved solute particles per kilogram of blood serum; see *Osmolality Blood Test*.

Serum Phenylalanine Screening

A blood test measuring phenylalanine, used in newborn screening and follow-up of phenylketonuria or other disorders of phenylalanine metabolism.

Serum Progesterone

A blood test measuring progesterone, a hormone made mainly after ovulation and during pregnancy. The result can help assess ovulation, ovarian function, fertility treatment, or early pregnancy, but interpretation depends strongly on timing and pregnancy status.

Serum Protein Electrophoresis

A blood test that separates proteins in serum into groups. It can show abnormal antibody production or low protein levels and is often followed by immunofixation when a plasma-cell disorder is suspected.

Serum Sickness

A delayed immune reaction, usually one to three weeks after exposure to certain medicines, injected proteins, or antiserum. It can cause fever, rash or hives, painful swollen joints, enlarged lymph nodes, and sometimes organ problems.

Serum Therapy

Prevention or treatment using antibody-containing plasma, immunoglobulin, antitoxin, or antivenom. It provides immediate but usually temporary protection against a specific infection or toxin; allergic reactions and other infusion-related problems are possible.

Serum Uric Acid

A blood test measuring uric acid, a purine-breakdown product. The result helps assess gout, kidney stones, kidney function, or effects of some cancer treatments.

Serum Uric Acid Test

A blood test measuring the concentration of uric acid, the final breakdown product of purine metabolism, used in the diagnosis of gout and hyperuricemia; see *Serum Uric Acid*.

Serving Size

Serving size is the standardized amount used to describe the nutrients or calories in food and may differ from the amount a person actually eats.

Sesamoid Bones

Small bones embedded within or beside tendons, where they protect the tendon and improve leverage. Examples include the kneecap and the small bones beneath the big toe.

Sesamoiditis

Painful inflammation of tissues around a sesamoid bone, most often beneath the big toe. Pain usually worsens with walking, running, dancing, or pressure on the front of the foot.

Sesquipedalian

Sesquipedalian means characterized by very long words; clear healthcare communication favors language that patients can understand.

Sessile

Attached directly by a broad base rather than a narrow stalk. A sessile polyp can be harder to remove completely, and its broad shape may conceal abnormal tissue.

Set

In exercise, a group of consecutive repetitions performed before a rest period. In medicine, "set" can also mean a prepared group of instruments, tests, or equipment.

Sever Disease

A painful irritation of the growth area at the back of the heel in growing children, often during sports. Heel pain worsens with running or jumping and usually improves with activity adjustment, heel support, calf stretching, and time.

Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome

A serious contagious respiratory illness caused by the SARS-associated coronavirus, SARS-CoV. It usually begins with fever and may cause chills, muscle aches, headache, diarrhea, dry cough, and breathing difficulty. Most affected people develop pneumonia, which can progress to low blood oxygen, respiratory failure, and death. The name usually refers to the disease identified in the 2002–2004 outbreak; SARS-CoV-2 causes COVID-19, a different disease.

Severe Brain Injury Coma

Alternate name; see *Coma*.

Severe Combined Immunodeficiency

A group of inherited conditions in which important immune cells do not develop or work properly. Affected babies can develop severe, repeated infections early in life; treatment may include immune-restoring therapies such as stem-cell transplantation or gene therapy.

Severe Combined Immunodeficiency (SCID)

Alternate name; see *Severe Combined Immunodeficiency*.

Severe Dengue

Dengue with severe leakage of fluid from blood vessels causing shock or breathing difficulty, severe bleeding, or serious organ damage such as liver, brain, or heart injury. It can become life-threatening.

Alternate Names:
Severe Dengue Virus Infection; Critical Dengue

Severe Falciparum Malaria

Severe malaria caused by Plasmodium falciparum. It may involve cerebral malaria, severe anemia, hypoglycemia, metabolic acidosis, kidney injury, respiratory distress, shock, or multiple-organ dysfunction.

Severe Hearing Loss

Hearing loss that substantially limits access to speech or environmental sound. It may be conductive, sensorineural, or mixed and may require hearing aids, cochlear implantation, communication support, or treatment of an underlying cause.

Severe Obesity

Obesity with a body mass index (BMI) of 40 kg/m^2 or higher, commonly classified as class 3 obesity. BMI is a screening measure and does not fully describe a person's health.

Alternate Names:
Class III Obesity; Extreme Obesity

Sevoflurane

An inhaled anesthetic gas used to start and maintain general anesthesia. It acts in the brain to produce unconsciousness and reduces awareness of pain; it can lower breathing and blood pressure and may trigger malignant hyperthermia in susceptible people.

Sex Change

An outdated, imprecise term sometimes used for gender-affirming care, which may include social, hormonal, or surgical interventions. Use the specific care or procedure name when known.

Sex Chromosomes

The X and Y chromosomes, which contribute to sex development and carry many other genes.

Sex Cord-Stromal Ovarian Tumor

A group of ovarian tumors arising from sex cord or stromal cells, including granulosa-cell, Sertoli-Leydig cell, and thecoma-fibroma tumors. Some produce hormones; behavior varies by tumor type.

Sex Headaches

Headaches brought on by sexual activity, including a gradually increasing ache or a sudden severe headache at orgasm. A first or thunderclap headache can signal bleeding or another dangerous cause.

Sex Hormones

Hormones involved in sexual development, reproduction, menstrual cycles, pregnancy, and related body functions. Major groups include estrogens, progesterone, and androgens, which also affect bones, muscles, mood, and tissues.

Sex-Linked Dominant

A pattern of inheritance in which a disease-causing gene variant lies on a sex chromosome and one altered copy can cause the condition. The chance of passing it on differs for mothers and fathers and for children of different sexes.

Sex-Linked Inheritance

Inheritance of a trait caused by a gene on a sex chromosome, commonly the X chromosome.

Sex-Linked Recessive

A pattern in which a disease-causing gene variant, usually on the X chromosome, commonly causes disease in males with one altered copy. Females usually need two altered copies, while those with one may be carriers or have milder symptoms.

Sex Therapy

Structured psychological or behavioral therapy for sexual concerns or dysfunction.

Sexual Abuse

Nonconsensual sexual contact, exploitation, or behavior; it is a safeguarding and health emergency when immediate danger or injury exists.

Sexual Addiction

Legacy label; see *Compulsive Sexual Behavior Disorder*.

Sexual Assault

Any sexual contact or sexual act without freely given consent, including unwanted touching, penetration, coercion, or sexual activity when a person cannot consent. It can cause injury, infection, pregnancy, and psychological trauma.

Alternate Names:
Nonconsensual Sexual Contact; Sexual Violence

Sexual Assault Prevention

Sexual-assault prevention includes consent education, recognizing coercion, safer environments, bystander intervention, and access to confidential support; responsibility always lies with the person who commits the assault.

Sexual Dysfunction

A group of conditions involving persistent or recurrent difficulty with sexual desire, arousal, erection, ejaculation, orgasm, or pain that causes clinically significant distress. Causes may be physical, psychological, medication-related, hormonal, or related to life circumstances.

Sexual Dysfunction Disorders

Alternate name; see *Sexual Dysfunction*.

Sexual Health

Sexual health includes physical, emotional, mental,

and social well-being related to sexuality. It includes contraception, fertility, consent, relationships, and prevention of sexually transmitted infections.

Sexual Intercourse

Sexual activity involving penetration, most commonly penile-vaginal, but sometimes penile-anal or other forms depending on the people involved. It may be for pleasure, intimacy, or reproduction and requires freely given consent.

Alternate Names:
Copulation; Coition; Sexual Union

Sexually Transmitted Disease

An infection or clinical illness transmitted predominantly through sexual contact (vaginal, anal, or oral sex) or vertical perinatal transmission from mother to infant. Etiologies include bacterial (*Chlamydia trachomatis*, *Neisseria gonorrhoeae*, *Treponema pallidum*), viral (HIV, herpes simplex virus, human papillomavirus, hepatitis B), protozoal (*Trichomonas vaginalis*), and ectoparasitic pathogens. Clinical manifestations include urethral/vaginal discharge, genital ulcers, pelvic inflammatory disease, infertility, or chronic systemic disease; contemporary clinical terminology increasingly prefers the broader term sexually transmitted infection (STI) to encompass asymptomatic infection.

Alternate Names:
Sexually Transmitted Diseases; STD; STDs; Sexually Transmitted Infection; Sexually Transmitted Infections; STI; STIs

Sexually Transmitted Diseases

Plural form; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Diseases in Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Diseases in Women

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Disease (STD)

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Disease Treatments

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Infection

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexually Transmitted Infections

Plural form; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Sexual Masochism Disorder

A mental-health diagnosis involving repeated sexual arousal from being humiliated, beaten, bound, or otherwise made to suffer, when the pattern causes significant distress or disrupts daily life, or involves a person who has not freely consented.

Sexual Obsession

An unwanted, intrusive sexual thought, image, or urge that causes distress, often discussed in obsessive-compulsive disorder. It is distinct from compulsive sexual behavior, which involves difficulty controlling repeated behavior.

Sexual Rehabilitation

Assessment and treatment to help restore or adapt sexual function after illness, injury, surgery, disability, or medicine effects. It may include education, counseling, pelvic-floor therapy, devices, or medicines.

Sexual Sadism

A recurrent sexual interest in another person's physical or psychological suffering or humiliation. The interest alone is not a mental disorder; acts without consent are abuse.

Sexual Sadism Disorder

A mental-health diagnosis involving repeated sexual arousal from another person's physical or emotional suffering, when it causes clinically significant distress or impairment or involves acting with someone who has not freely consented.

Sexual Violence

Sexual violence is any sexual act, attempt, contact,

or coercion without freely given consent and can cause physical injury, infection, pregnancy, trauma, and long-term health effects.

Sezary Disease

Alternate name; see *Sezary Syndrome*.

Sezary Syndrome

An uncommon form of cutaneous T-cell lymphoma involving widespread red skin and abnormal lymphocytes in the blood.

Alternate Names:
Sezary Disease; Mycosis Fungoides Variant

SéZary Syndrome

An uncommon form of skin lymphoma in which abnormal immune cells are found in the skin and blood. It usually causes widespread red, scaly, itchy skin and enlarged lymph nodes and requires specialist care.

Sgarbossa Criteria

A set of electrocardiogram findings used to look for a heart attack when an existing conduction problem or pacemaker makes the tracing difficult to read. The findings can support, but cannot prove, an acute blocked heart artery.

Shadowing Artifact

An ultrasound artifact in which a strongly attenuating or reflecting structure produces a dark area behind it because little sound reaches the tissues beyond. Stones, bone, and gas commonly cause shadowing.

Shaken Baby Syndrome

Older term; see *Abusive Head Trauma*.

Shaken Impact Syndrome

A nonstandard term sometimes used for abusive head trauma in infants and children. The preferred term is abusive head trauma, which describes injury from inflicted impact, shaking, or both.

Shampoo Ingestion

Accidental swallowing of a small amount of shampoo usually causes mouth or stomach irritation; larger or concentrated exposures may cause vomiting or breathing problems and warrant poison-control advice.

Shared Decision-Making

A collaborative process in which clinicians and patients combine best available evidence with patient values, preferences, goals, and circumstances to choose among reasonable options.

Shark Attack

A shark attack can cause severe lacerations, bleeding, tissue loss, drowning, and shock; emergency rescue, hemorrhage control, and trauma care are critical.

Sharp-Force Defense Wounds

Cuts or other injuries on the hands or forearms that may occur when a person attempts to protect against an attack. The distribution and morphology of defensive injuries may help reconstruct an assault but are not independently proof of a particular event.

Alternate Names:
Defensive Wounds; Defense Injuries

Sharp Force Trauma

An injury caused by a sharp or pointed object, such as a knife, broken glass, or needle. It may produce a cut or a deeper puncture and can damage blood vessels, nerves, organs, or bones; deep wounds can cause severe blood loss or internal injury.

Sharps Container

A strong, leak-resistant container for used needles, lancets, blades, and other sharp medical items. It is designed to reduce needlestick injury and infection and is labeled, puncture-resistant, and closable.

Sharps Injury

A percutaneous or mucocutaneous injury caused by a needle or other sharp instrument that may

expose a person to blood or body fluids. Immediate wound care, incident reporting, risk assessment, and pathogen-specific post-exposure management are required.

Shave Biopsy

Removal of a raised or superficial skin lesion by shaving off a thin layer with a sterile blade. The tissue is examined under a microscope; bleeding, infection, scarring, or an inadequate sample can occur.

Sheath

A hollow tube that provides access through the skin and into a blood vessel or body passage for insertion and exchange of catheters or other devices.

Sheehan's Syndrome

Loss of pituitary hormones caused by damage to the pituitary gland after severe bleeding or dangerously low blood pressure during or after childbirth. It may cause inability to breastfeed, extreme tiredness, low blood pressure, menstrual changes, or other hormone deficiencies.

Sheehan Syndrome

Permanent injury to the pituitary gland caused by severe bleeding or very low blood pressure during or after childbirth. Because the gland makes several hormones, symptoms may include inability to breastfeed, low blood pressure, fatigue, and menstrual or fertility problems.

Alternate Names:
Simmonds Disease; Postpartum Hypopituitarism

Shellac Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing or inhaling shellac, a coating product that may contain alcohol or other solvents. It can cause irritation, vomiting, dizziness, drowsiness, or lung injury if it enters the lungs.

Shellfish Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins in crustaceans or mollusks that can cause hives, digestive or respiratory symptoms, or anaphylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Crustacean Hypersensitivity; Shellfish Hypersensitivity

Shellfish Poisoning

Illness caused by toxins accumulated in contaminated shellfish. Depending on the toxin, symptoms may include vomiting, diarrhea, tingling, weakness, confusion, breathing difficulty, or paralysis; severe cases can be fatal.

Shielding

Material placed between a person and a source of radiation to reduce exposure. The material depends on the radiation: lead or tungsten is used for many X-rays and gamma rays, while plastic or acrylic can be useful for beta radiation.

Shifting Dullness

A change in the sound made when tapping the belly as a person turns onto their side, showing that extra fluid is shifting with gravity inside the stomach cavity.

Shift Work Sleep Disorder

A circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorder caused by a recurring work schedule that overlaps the usual sleep period, producing insomnia and/or excessive sleepiness, reduced sleep, and impaired functioning. Symptoms persist in association with the schedule, typically for at least 3 months.

Alternate Names:
SWSD; Shift-Work Sleep Disorder

Shiga Toxin-Producing Escherichia coli Infection

Infection caused by Shiga toxin-producing strains of Escherichia coli. It commonly causes diarrhea and abdominal cramps and may cause bloody diarrhea. A small number of people, especially children, develop hemolytic uremic syndrome, which can damage the kidneys.

Alternate Names:
STEC; Shiga Toxin-Producing E. coli Infection; Verocytotoxin-Producing E. coli Infection

Shigella

A genus of bacteria causing shigellosis, an acute diarrheal illness that may include fever and bloody stools.

Shigellosis

Shigellosis is intestinal infection caused by Shigella bacteria, producing diarrhea that may be bloody, fever, cramps, and dehydration.

Shilajit

Shilajit is a mineral-rich, resin-like substance used in some traditional medicines. Product purity and safety vary, and contamination with heavy metals is possible.

Shin Bone Fever

An older nonspecific term for painful inflammation or infection involving the shin or nearby tissues.

Shingles

Alternate name; see *Herpes Zoster*.

Shingles And Pregnancy

Shingles is reactivation of varicella-zoster virus and usually causes a painful one-sided blistering rash. It is distinct from primary chickenpox; pregnancy can affect treatment choices and the significance of contact with susceptible people.

Shin Splints

A common term for medial tibial stress syndrome, an overuse injury causing pain and tenderness along the inner border of the shinbone. It is associated with repetitive impact or a sudden increase in activity and involves irritation of tissues around the bone. It is distinct from a stress fracture and acute compartment syndrome, which are separate causes of lower-leg pain.

Alternate Names:
Medial Tibial Stress Syndrome

Shin Spot

A shin spot is a nonspecific mark or lesion on the lower leg; its significance depends on appearance, duration, symptoms, injury, and associated disease.

Shirodkar Cerclage

An operation that places a strong stitch high around the cervix to help prevent it opening too early during pregnancy. It is used in selected people at risk of late miscarriage or premature birth and can cause bleeding, infection, or injury to nearby organs.

Shisha

Shisha is tobacco or another smoking mixture used in a water pipe. The water does not remove the main toxic substances, and smoking shisha can expose users to nicotine, carbon monoxide, and cancer-causing chemicals.

Shivering

Repeated, involuntary muscle contractions that generate heat, usually in response to cold or fever. Severe or unexplained shivering may occur with infection, medicine reactions, or other illness.

Shock

A life-threatening failure of circulation in which organs do not receive enough blood and oxygen. It can result from severe blood or fluid loss, heart failure, overwhelming infection, a severe allergic reaction, or an obstruction to blood flow. Signs may include confusion, faintness, cold or mottled skin, rapid breathing, little urine, or very low blood pressure.

Shock and Pregnancy

Life-threatening inadequate tissue perfusion during pregnancy or after birth, caused by hemorrhage, sepsis, cardiogenic disease, embolism, anaphylaxis, or other processes. Rapid maternal resuscitation, hemorrhage or infection control, and fetal assessment are essential.

Shock Lung

Older term; see *Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome*.

Shock Wave Lithotripsy

A procedure that focuses repeated sound-pressure waves from outside the body onto a kidney or ureter stone to break it into smaller pieces that can pass in urine. Blood in the urine, pain, blockage, infection, or incomplete stone removal can occur.

Shone Complex

A group of congenital left-sided obstructive heart lesions, classically including supravalvular mitral ring, parachute mitral valve, subaortic stenosis, and coarctation of the aorta. The combination and severity vary and may lead to heart failure or systemic outflow obstruction.

Short Arm Of A Chromosome

The shorter section of a chromosome, labeled p from the French word for "small." Missing, extra, or rearranged DNA in this section can alter genes and cause disease.

Short Bones

Small, roughly cube-shaped bones that provide stability and limited movement. The wrist and ankle contain most of the body's short bones.

Short Bowel Syndrome

A condition in which the small intestine is shortened or damaged and cannot absorb enough nutrients from food. It most often occurs after surgery to remove part of the small intestine and may cause diarrhea, weight loss, and nutritional deficiencies.

Short-Chain Fatty Acids

Small fatty substances made when bacteria in the large intestine break down dietary fiber. They help nourish the bowel lining and may influence inflammation and metabolism; their effects vary with diet and the person's gut bacteria.

Shortness Of Breath

Alternate name; see *Dyspnea*.

Short Philtrum

A short philtrum is reduced distance between the nose and upper lip and may be an isolated feature or part of a genetic, developmental, or prenatal-exposure syndrome.

Short QT Syndrome

A rare inherited heart-rhythm disorder in which the heart's electrical recovery time is unusually short. It can cause atrial or ventricular arrhythmias, fainting, or sudden cardiac death; diagnosis requires specialist ECG and family-history assessment, and treatment may include an implantable defibrillator.

Alternate Names:
SQTS

Short-Sight

Myopia, a refractive error in which distant objects are focused in front of the retina.

Short Stature

Height substantially below the expected range for age and sex, requiring assessment of growth pattern and cause.

Short-Term Memory

The ability to hold and use a small amount of information for seconds or minutes. It helps with following instructions, doing mental tasks, and remembering a recent conversation before information is stored more permanently or forgotten.

Alternate Names:
Immediate Memory

Shotty

Describes small, firm, discrete lymph nodes, often reactive after infection; persistent, enlarging, hard, or generalized nodes may have causes other than a recent infection.

Shoulder

The area where the upper limb joins the body, including the shoulder blade, collarbone, and upper-arm bone. Its main joint allows a wide range of arm movement but is less stable and can be injured or dislocated.

Shoulder Arthroscopy

A minimally invasive procedure using a camera and instruments through small incisions to diagnose and treat selected disorders of the shoulder joint and surrounding tissues.

Shoulder Bursitis

Inflammation of a fluid-filled sac around the shoulder, often associated with rotator-cuff disease or repetitive overhead activity. Pain with arm elevation and lying on the affected side is common; treatment options include activity modification, therapy, medicines, or injection.

Alternate Names:
Subacromial Bursitis; Subdeltoid Bursitis

Shoulder CT Scan

Computed tomography of the shoulder used to evaluate fractures, bone alignment, arthritis, tumors, infection, and complex bony anatomy.

Shoulder Dislocation

Complete displacement of the upper arm bone from the shoulder socket, usually caused by a fall, collision, or forceful twisting. It causes severe pain, deformity, and inability to move the arm and may injure nearby bones, nerves, or blood vessels.

Shoulder Dystocia

A childbirth emergency in which the baby's head is born but a shoulder becomes stuck behind the birthing parent's pelvic bone. Delivery maneuvers are used to free the shoulder; delay can cause lack of oxygen, fractures, or nerve injury in the baby and heavy bleeding in the parent.

Shoulder Impingement

Older term; see *Subacromial Pain Syndrome*.

Shoulder Impingement Syndrome

Older term; see *Subacromial Pain Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
Subacromial Impingement Syndrome; Neer Impingement

Shoulder Instability

Excessive or recurrent movement of the shoulder joint caused by injury, laxity, or altered joint anatomy. Associated lesions may include a Bankart tear, Hill-Sachs lesion, or injury to the joint capsule or ligaments.

Shoulder MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the shoulder used to evaluate rotator-cuff tendons, labrum, cartilage, ligaments, muscles, bone marrow, and joint fluid.

Shoulder Pain

Pain in or around the shoulder caused by injury, tendon or bursa disorders, arthritis, nerve disease, or referred pain. Sudden weakness, deformity, chest symptoms, fever, or pain after major trauma can indicate a serious cause.

Shoulder Replacement

Surgery replacing damaged surfaces of the shoulder with artificial parts to relieve severe pain and improve movement. The implant may replace the joint in the usual or reverse configuration; infection, stiffness, dislocation, loosening, or nerve injury can occur.

Shulman Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Eosinophilic Fasciitis*.

Shunt

A passage that diverts blood, cerebrospinal fluid, urine, or another fluid from one channel to another.

Shwachman Syndrome

An inherited multisystem disorder usually involving exocrine pancreatic insufficiency, bone-marrow dysfunction, and skeletal abnormalities. Children may have steatorrhea, poor growth, recurrent infections, neutropenia, anemia, or increased risk of myeloid malignancy.

Shy-Drager Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Multiple System Atrophy*.

SIADH

A condition in which the body releases too much antidiuretic hormone, causing it to retain water and dilute the blood sodium level. It may cause nausea, headache, confusion, seizures, or coma and requires treatment of the cause and sodium abnormality.

Sialadenitis

Inflammation or infection of a saliva-making gland, causing painful swelling near the cheek or under the jaw, often worse during meals. Causes include bacteria, viruses, dehydration, or a blocked tube that carries saliva. Pus may mean a pocket of infection has formed.

Sialagogues

Substances or medicines that increase saliva production. They may help some people with dry mouth, but treatment also considers hydration, medicines, oral care, and the cause of reduced saliva.

Sialidosis (Mucolipidosis Type I)

A rare inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient alpha-neuraminidase, usually because of *NEU1* variants. It may cause coarse facial features, skeletal or eye abnormalities, myoclonus, ataxia, developmental impairment, or vision problems, with severity varying by type.

Sialogram

An imaging study of a salivary gland and its ducts after contrast is introduced through the duct opening, used to assess obstruction, stones, strictures, or chronic inflammation.

Sialography

An imaging procedure that uses contrast material to show salivary glands and their ducts. It can help identify blockage, stones, narrowing, chronic inflammation, or tumors, although newer imaging is often preferred.

Sialolithiasis

A stone in a saliva-making gland or the tube that carries saliva into the mouth, most often in a gland under the jaw. It can cause repeated swelling and pain during meals and may block saliva or lead to infection.

Sialorrhea

Excess saliva or difficulty controlling and swallowing it, causing drooling. It commonly occurs with neurologic disease, swallowing difficulty, dental problems, or some medicines; treatment addresses the cause and may include swallowing therapy or selected medicines.

Sialorrhoea

Excess saliva that pools in the mouth or dribbles out as drooling. It is often caused by difficulty controlling or swallowing saliva rather than making too much. It may occur with cerebral palsy, Parkinson disease, motor-neuron disease, or other conditions and can cause skin irritation or choking. Swallowing therapy and other treatments may help.

Sialuria

A rare inherited disorder in which cells make and release too much sialic acid, a sugar used on cell surfaces. It may cause developmental delay, enlarged liver and spleen, distinctive facial features, and variable learning difficulties.

Sibling

A person's brother or sister; family history from siblings can inform genetic and disease risk assessment.

SIBO

Alternate name; see *Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth*.

Sicca Syndrome

Persistent dryness of the eyes and mouth caused by reduced tears and saliva. It may result from Sjögren syndrome, medicines, dehydration, radiation, or other illnesses and can lead to eye irritation, mouth sores, tooth decay, or difficulty swallowing.

Sickle Cell

An inherited group of blood disorders caused by

abnormal hemoglobin. Red blood cells may become rigid and curved, causing anemia, severe pain, blocked blood flow, and damage to organs.

Sickle-Cell Anaemia

See *Sickle Cell Anemia*.

Sickle Cell Anemia

A form of sickle cell disease, usually caused by inheriting two hemoglobin S genes (HbSS); HbS beta-zero thalassemia is also sometimes grouped with it. Rigid, sickle-shaped red cells break down early and can block small blood vessels, causing anemia, pain, stroke, lung complications, jaundice, and infection risk.

Sickle Cell Crisis

A sudden complication of sickle cell disease. Most often, stiff, sickle-shaped red blood cells block small blood vessels and cause severe pain. Other crises can cause sudden lung problems, a rapid drop in red blood cells, or blood to collect in the spleen.

Sickle Cell Dactylitis

Painful swelling of the hands or feet caused by blockage of small blood vessels during a sickle-cell episode, especially in infants and young children. It may be an early sign of sickle-cell disease and requires appropriate clinical evaluation.

Sickle Cell Disease

A group of autosomal recessive inherited hemoglobin disorders involving hemoglobin S, which can make red blood cells rigid and prone to sickling. Sickling and red-cell breakdown can cause anemia, episodes of blocked blood flow, and damage to organs; forms include hemoglobin SS, hemoglobin SC, and hemoglobin Sbeta-thalassemia.

Sickle Cell Test

A laboratory test detecting hemoglobin S or assessing sickling, used in screening and diagnosis of sickle-cell trait or sickle-cell disease; definitive testing identifies hemoglobin variants.

Sickle Cell Trait

An inherited state in which a person has one gene for hemoglobin S and one usual hemoglobin gene. Most people have no symptoms and do not develop sickle cell disease, but rare problems can occur with severe dehydration, low oxygen, or extreme exertion.

Sick Sinus Syndrome

A problem with the heart's natural pacemaker that causes the heartbeat to become too slow, pause, or alternate between fast and slow. It may cause dizziness, fainting, tiredness, palpitations, or reduced exercise ability.

Alternate Names:
Bradycardia-Tachycardia Syndrome

Side Effect

Any unintended, non-targeted secondary physiological effect produced by a pharmaceutical agent or medical intervention occurring at standard therapeutic doses, which may be beneficial, neutral, or harmful (adverse drug reaction). Commonly arising from off-target binding or predictable extension of primary on-target pharmacology across non-target tissues (e.g., dry mouth from anticholinergics, sedation from first-generation antihistamines).

Alternate Names:
Side Effects; Adverse Effect; Adverse Drug Reaction

Side Effects

Plural form; see *Side Effect*.

Side-Effects

Unintended effects that occur while a medicine or treatment is used. They range from mild symptoms to serious harm; the risk depends on the treatment, dose, duration, other medicines, and the person's health.

Sideroblastic Anemia

Anemia caused by faulty hemoglobin production. Iron builds up inside developing red blood cells instead of being used properly; causes include inherited disorders, alcohol, some medicines or toxins, vitamin B6 deficiency, and bone-marrow disease.

Siderosis

Accumulation of iron in body tissues, or lung disease from breathing iron-containing dust. It may cause no symptoms, but long-term dust exposure can produce cough, breathing difficulty, and permanent lung damage.

SIDS

Abbreviation; see *Sudden Infant Death Syndrome*.

Sievert

A unit used to estimate how much biological harm ionizing radiation could cause. It accounts for the type of radiation and the sensitivity of different tissues and is used when discussing radiation risk.

Alternate Names:
Equivalent Radiation Dose Unit; Sv Unit

Sight

The ability to see, involving the eyes and visual nervous system.

Sigmoid

Sigmoid means S-shaped; the sigmoid colon is the curved section of large intestine between the descending colon and rectum.

Sigmoid Colon

The curved, S-shaped section of the large intestine between the descending colon and rectum. It stores stool before bowel movements and is a common site for diverticular disease, twisting, and colorectal cancer.

Sigmoidoscopy

Endoscopic examination of the rectum and lower colon using a flexible or rigid sigmoidoscope. It can identify inflammation, bleeding, polyps, or tumors and may allow biopsy or treatment.

Sigmoid Volvulus

Twisting of the S-shaped lower colon around the tissue that supports it, blocking the bowel. It can cause severe abdominal swelling, pain, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas; prolonged twisting can cut off the blood supply and cause bowel death.

Sign

An observable or measurable finding that may show disease or a change in health. Examples include a rash, fever, swelling, abnormal heartbeat, or high blood pressure; a sign differs from a symptom, which is felt and reported by the person.

Signal Peptide

A short part of a newly made protein that acts like an address label, directing the protein to the cell membrane, outside the cell, or a particular internal compartment. It is often removed after delivery.

Signal-To-Noise Ratio

A comparison between the useful information in a test or image and the unwanted background variation. A higher ratio usually produces a clearer image or more reliable measurement.

Signal Transduction

The chain of events by which a hormone, nerve chemical, or medicine attaches to a cell and produces a response inside it. The response can change cell activity, movement, growth, survival, or gene use.

Signature

A signature is a person's identifying mark or electronic confirmation of approval, consent, authorship, or verification.

Signature Strengths

Personal character strengths that a person values and naturally uses.

Signet Ring Cell Carcinoma

A cancer whose cells contain mucus that pushes the cell nucleus to one side, giving a ring-like appearance under a microscope. It most often begins in the stomach or colon and may grow widely or aggressively.

Sign Language

Sign language is a complete visual language using

hand shape, movement, position, facial expression, and body movement rather than spoken sound.

Sign of Leser-Trelat

The sudden appearance or rapid increase of numerous seborrheic keratoses, sometimes reported as a paraneoplastic sign. Most seborrheic keratoses are harmless and common, so the pattern alone does not establish an underlying cancer.

Signs Of An Asthma Attack

An asthma attack may cause worsening wheeze, cough, chest tightness, breathlessness, rapid breathing, difficulty speaking, or reduced peak flow; severe attacks can cause respiratory failure.

Sildenafil Citrate

The citrate salt of sildenafil, a phosphodiesterase type 5 inhibitor used for erectile dysfunction and pulmonary arterial hypertension. It relaxes vascular smooth muscle through nitric-oxide signaling. Use with organic nitrates or riociguat is contraindicated because the combination can cause severe hypotension.

Silent Heart Attack

A heart attack that causes no recognized pain or typical warning signs. It may be discovered later through an electrocardiogram or imaging and still damages heart muscle and increases future risks.

Alternate Names:
Unrecognized Myocardial Infarction; Silent MI

Silent Ischemia

Reduced blood flow to heart muscle without typical chest pain or other recognized symptoms. It may still damage the heart and is detected through testing rather than symptoms alone.

Alternate Names:
Asymptomatic Myocardial Ischemia

Silent Mutation

A DNA change that usually does not alter the amino acid in the protein made from the gene. It may still affect how the gene is copied, how long its RNA lasts, or how much protein is produced.

Silent Myocardial Infarction

A heart attack that occurs without recognized typical symptoms and is discovered later from medical records or testing. An electrocardiogram may suggest an old infarction, but abnormal Q waves alone are not specific; cardiac imaging can help confirm prior heart-muscle injury.

Alternate Names:
Unrecognized Myocardial Infarction; Painless MI

Silent Sinus Syndrome

Silent sinus syndrome is painless inward collapse of the maxillary sinus and floor of the orbit, often causing facial asymmetry, enophthalmos, or a sunken eye. Imaging confirms the diagnosis, and endoscopic treatment restores sinus ventilation when indicated.

Silent Thyroiditis

Silent thyroiditis is painless autoimmune inflammation of the thyroid that may briefly release excess hormone before causing temporary hypothyroidism and eventual recovery.

Silicate

A salt or ester containing silicon and oxygen, found in minerals and industrial materials; inhalation of some silicate dusts can irritate the lungs or contribute to pneumoconiosis.

Silicon Dioxide

A mineral found in soil, rock, dust, and industrial materials. Breathing crystalline forms over time can scar the lungs, cause silicosis, and increase the risk of lung cancer.

Silicone

A synthetic polymer composed of repeating siloxane units (silicon and oxygen backbone with attached organic methyl, phenyl, or vinyl groups). Biologically inert, heat-resistant, and flexible, medical-grade silicones are widely used in biomedical implants (e.g., breast implants, intraocular lenses), indwelling catheters, wound dressings, and scar therapy sheets; complications can include fibrous capsu-

lar contracture, rupture, or granulomatous foreign body reaction.

Alternate Names:
Silicones; Polysiloxane

Silicone Elastomer

A flexible, rubber-like silicone material used in implants, tubing, dressings, and other devices; complications may include infection, leakage, allergy, or device failure.

Silicone Implants

Medical implants containing silicone gel or elastomer used for breast reconstruction or augmentation; complications may include rupture, capsular contracture, infection, malposition, or need for revision.

Silicone Mastitis

A granulomatous inflammatory reaction to silicone released from a breast implant or injected silicone. It may cause nodules, pain, lymphadenopathy, or imaging findings that mimic malignancy.

Silicone Oil Hyperoleon

A complication after eye surgery in which silicone oil breaks into tiny droplets and moves into the front of the eye. It can raise eye pressure, irritate the eye, damage the cornea, and sometimes requires removal or washing of the oil.

Silicones

Plural form; see *Silicone*.

Silicosis

A permanent lung-scarring disease caused by breathing crystalline silica dust. It can cause cough, breathlessness, reduced lung function, tuberculosis risk, and progressive respiratory disability after workplace or environmental exposure.

Silk

Silk is a protein fiber used in textiles and some medical sutures or biomaterials; reactions and tissue response depend on the product and processing.

Silk Road Disease

Alternate name; see *Behcet Syndrome*.

Siltuximab

A monoclonal antibody that binds interleukin-6 and is used to treat adults with multicentric Castleman disease who are negative for HIV and human herpesvirus 8.

Silver

A metal used in some dressings, creams, and medical devices for antimicrobial activity; excessive exposure can cause permanent blue-gray skin discoloration called argyria.

Silver Diamine Fluoride

A liquid applied to a tooth to slow or stop active tooth decay. It usually turns the treated decayed area black and may be useful when drilling or immediate restorative treatment is difficult.

Silver Nitrate

A caustic antiseptic used topically to cauterize tissue, control minor bleeding, or treat some wounds; it can burn healthy skin and permanently stain tissue.

Silver Poisoning

Silver poisoning, or argyria, follows excessive silver exposure and can cause permanent blue-gray skin discoloration and, rarely, organ or neurologic effects.

Silver-Russell Syndrome

A growth disorder usually present from birth, marked by poor growth before and after birth, a small or asymmetrical body, and characteristic facial features. Most cases are linked to changes in gene activity rather than a change in the gene itself.

Silver Sulfadiazine

A topical antimicrobial cream formerly used widely for burns; it may delay healing in some wounds and is not appropriate for everyone, including some newborns and people with sulfonamide allergy.

Silymarin

A mixture of flavonolignans from milk thistle marketed as a dietary supplement; evidence for treating liver disease is limited and product quality varies.

Simeprevir

An older hepatitis C virus NS3/4A protease inhibitor formerly used with other antivirals; it is no longer a usual first-line treatment because better direct-acting regimens are available.

Simethicone

Simethicone is a non-absorbed antifoaming agent that coalesces gas bubbles in the gastrointestinal tract and is used for symptomatic relief of bloating; it does not treat the underlying cause of pain.

Simian Crease

A simian crease is a single transverse crease across the palm, which may be a normal variant or occur with some chromosomal or developmental conditions.

Simmonds Disease

An older term for severe pituitary-gland failure. It can cause extreme tiredness, weight loss, low blood pressure, loss of menstrual periods or sexual function, and deficiencies of several hormones.

Simmonds Test

A calf-squeeze test for a possible torn Achilles tendon. If squeezing the calf does not make the foot point downward, a tear is suspected, but examination and sometimes imaging are needed.

Alternate Names:
Thompson Test; Thompson-Simmonds Calf Squeeze Test

Simmonds-Thompson Test

Another name for the calf-squeeze test used when an Achilles tendon tear is suspected. A missing downward movement of the foot supports the diagnosis but does not replace a full assessment.

Alternate Names:
Thompson Test; Simmonds Test

Simple Febrile Seizure

A generalized seizure in a febrile child aged 6–60 months, without central nervous system infection, metabolic disturbance, or a history of afebrile seizures. It lasts less than 15 minutes and occurs only once in a 24-hour period.

Alternate Names:
Benign Febrile Seizure; Typical Febrile Seizure

Simple Goiter

A simple goiter is noncancerous enlargement of the thyroid without obvious thyroid-hormone excess or deficiency, caused by iodine imbalance, stimulation, or other factors.

Simple Mastectomy

Simple mastectomy removes the breast tissue and nipple while leaving most chest muscles and usually the underarm lymph nodes.

Simple Prostatectomy

Surgical removal of the enlarged central portion of the prostate to relieve bladder-outlet obstruction from benign prostatic hyperplasia; it does not remove the entire prostate.

Simple Pulmonary Eosinophilia

A usually mild lung reaction in which eosinophils, a type of white blood cell, collect temporarily in the lungs. It may cause cough, fever, or wheezing and can follow medicines, parasites, or other exposures. Symptoms and chest shadows often clear on their own.

Simplexvirus

A genus of herpesviruses that includes herpes simplex virus types 1 and 2, which cause cold sores, genital herpes, and other infections.

Simpson Test

A bedside fatigability test used to assess neuromuscular transmission in suspected ocular myasthenia gravis. The patient is asked to maintain upward gaze for one minute; progressive worsening of ptosis or the development of diplopia constitutes a positive

test result.

Alternate Names:
Sustained Upward Gaze Test

Simuliidae

The family of black flies; bites can cause itchy skin reactions, and some species transmit Onchocerca volvulus, the parasite that causes river blindness.

Simultanagnosia

An inability to see more than one object, or the whole visual scene, at the same time even though basic eyesight may be adequate. It usually results from damage to brain areas that combine visual information.

Simvastatin

A statin medicine that lowers LDL, often called bad cholesterol, by reducing cholesterol production in the liver. It helps lower the risk of heart attack and stroke; muscle pain, liver problems, and medicine interactions are possible.

Sincalide

A synthetic form of cholecystokinin used during gallbladder imaging to stimulate contraction and measure bile flow; it may cause abdominal pain, nausea, or flushing.

Sindbis Virus

A mosquito-borne virus that can cause fever, rash, and joint pain. It occurs mainly in parts of Africa, Europe, Asia, and Australia.

Sinding-Larsen-Johansson Syndrome

A painful overuse injury at the lower tip of the kneecap in growing children and adolescents. Pain usually worsens with running or jumping and improves as growth finishes and the irritated area heals.

Sinecatechins

A topical green-tea catechin ointment for external genital and perianal warts caused by human papillomavirus; it can cause local irritation.

Singer's Nodule

A small, usually noncancerous thickening on a vocal fold caused by repeated voice strain. It can cause lasting hoarseness, a rough voice, or reduced vocal range; voice therapy and reducing strain are often helpful.

Singing

Singing is producing musical sounds with the voice. It can support communication and social well-being, while excessive or improper voice use may cause vocal strain.

Single-Dose Toxicity

Harm caused by one exposure to a substance or medicine, assessed according to dose, route, timing, and the exposed person's characteristics.

Single-Fiber Electromyography

A specialized electrical test that records signals from individual muscle fibers. It measures small variations in the timing of nerve-to-muscle communication and can detect disorders such as myasthenia gravis, even when routine nerve tests are normal. A fine needle is used, and the test may be uncomfortable.

Alternate Names:
SFEMG; Single-Fiber EMG

Single Nucleotide Polymorphism

A common inherited difference in one DNA building block. Most have little or no effect, but some are linked with disease risk, ancestry, or how a person responds to a medicine.

Single Palmar Crease

A single transverse palmar crease is one crease crossing the palm instead of the usual two; it can be a normal variant or a feature of genetic syndromes.

Single-Photon Absorptiometry

An older scan that used a small amount of radiation to estimate bone density, usually in an arm or other peripheral bone. More accurate bone-density methods have largely replaced it.

Alternate Names:
SPA

Single Photon Emission Computed Tomography

A nuclear medicine scan that uses a radioactive tracer and a rotating camera to create three-dimensional images of blood flow or organ function. It can assess the heart, bones, brain, kidneys, or other organs.

Single-Photon Emission Computed Tomography

A nuclear-medicine scan that uses a radioactive tracer and a rotating camera to create three-dimensional images of blood flow or organ activity. It can assess the heart, brain, bones, kidneys, and other organs.

Singlet Oxygen

A highly reactive form of oxygen involved in oxidative reactions, immune defenses, photodynamic therapy, and tissue injury from oxidative stress.

Single Ventricle

A group of heart defects present at birth in which one lower chamber does most of the work of pumping blood to both the body and lungs. Babies usually need specialist care and staged operations.

Singultus

Medical term for hiccups; see *Hiccups*.

Sin Nombre Virus Infection

Alternate name; see *Hantavirus Pulmonary Syndrome*.

Sinoatrial Block

A heart-rhythm problem in which an electrical signal from the heart's natural pacemaker is delayed or fails to spread to the upper chambers. It can cause missed beats, pauses, dizziness, or fainting.

Alternate Names:
SA Exit Block

Sinoatrial Node

A group of specialized cells in the right atrium that normally initiates the electrical impulse for each heartbeat; also called the sinus node.

Alternate Names:
SA Node

Sinuatrial Node

The sinoatrial node, a group of specialized cells in the right atrium that normally initiates the heartbeat and sets the cardiac rhythm.

Sinus

An anatomical cavity, channel, or hollow space, referring in medical anatomy to: (1) the paranasal sinuses (air-filled, mucosa-lined extensions of the nasal cavity within the frontal, maxillary, ethmoid, and sphenoid bones); (2) dural venous sinuses (endothelial-lined venous channels between layers of the dura mater); or (3) an abnormal blind-ended tract leading from a deep focus of suppuration to an epithelial or mucosal surface.

Alternate Names:
Sinuses; Paranasal Sinus

Sinus Arrest

A pause in the heartbeat caused when the heart's natural pacemaker briefly fails to produce an electrical signal. It may cause dizziness, fainting, or no symptoms and can result from heart-rhythm disease or medicine effects.

Alternate Names:
Sinus Pause

Sinus Arrhythmia

Sinus arrhythmia is normal variation in sinus-heart rate, commonly speeding during inhalation and slowing during exhalation, especially in young people.

Sinus Bradycardia

Sinus bradycardia is a sinus rhythm slower than the expected rate; it can be normal during sleep or athletic conditioning but may also reflect drugs or disease.

Sinus CT Scan

Computed tomography of the paranasal sinuses used to evaluate chronic or complicated sinusitis, anatomic obstruction, trauma, inflammatory disease, or tumors.

Sinuses

Plural form; see *Sinus*.

Sinus Headache

Pain attributed to a sinus headache is often migraine, but sinus inflammation can cause facial pressure, congestion, reduced smell, and pain that worsens with bending. Fever, purulent discharge, persistent symptoms, or eye or neurologic signs guide evaluation.

Sinus Histiocytosis

An increase in cleanup immune cells within the open spaces of a lymph node. It is often a response to nearby inflammation, infection, a tumor, or tissue breakdown and is interpreted with the rest of the biopsy.

Sinusitis

Inflammation of the lining of one or more paranasal sinuses. It may follow a viral respiratory infection or be associated with allergy, nasal inflammation, or other causes. Common features include nasal obstruction, discharge, facial pressure or pain, headache, and reduced smell. Acute and chronic forms differ in duration and pattern.

Sinusitis And Sinus Problems

Alternate name; see *Sinusitis*.

Sinus Lift

A dental procedure that adds bone beneath the lining of the maxillary sinus in the upper jaw. It may create enough support for a dental implant when the jawbone has become too thin.

Sinus MRI Scan

Magnetic resonance imaging of the paranasal sinuses and surrounding soft tissues used to evaluate tumors, invasive infection, orbital or intracranial extension, and selected inflammatory disease.

Sinus Node

Alternate name; see *Sinoatrial Node*.

Sinus Node Dysfunction

A disorder in which the heart's natural pacemaker does not generate or conduct impulses normally, causing rhythms that may be too slow, pauses, or alternating slow and fast rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Sinoatrial Node Dysfunction; Sick Sinus Syndrome

Sinusoid

A specialized, highly permeable capillary characterized by a wide, irregular lumen, discontinuous or absent basal lamina, and large fenestrae or intercellular gaps between endothelial cells. Found in the liver, spleen, bone marrow, and lymph nodes, sinusoids facilitate slow blood flow and unrestricted transcellular exchange of macromolecules, plasma proteins, and migrating blood cells between the bloodstream and parenchyma.

Alternate Names:
Sinusoids; Sinusoidal Capillary

Sinusoidal Fetal Heart Rate Pattern

A rare, smooth, regular wave pattern on an unborn baby's heart-rate tracing with little normal variation. It can indicate severe fetal anemia or low oxygen.

Sinusoidal Obstruction Syndrome

Injury and blockage of the small blood vessels in the liver, most often after high-dose chemotherapy given before a stem-cell transplant. It can cause painful liver enlargement, jaundice, fluid buildup, swelling of the abdomen, and rapid weight gain.

Alternate Names:
Hepatic Veno-Occlusive Disease; VOD/SOS

Sinusoids

Plural form; see *Sinusoid*.

Sinus Pain

Pressure or pain around the forehead, cheeks, nose, or eyes caused by sinus inflammation, infection, migraine, or other conditions. Severe headache, eye swelling, vision change, high fever, or neurologic symptoms can indicate a serious complication.

Sinus Rhomboidalis

A diamond-shaped depression forming the floor of the fourth brain ventricle, near structures controlling movement and vital functions.

Sinus Rhythm

A heart rhythm started by electrical impulses from the sinoatrial node, the natural pacemaker. It is usually regular, although sinus rhythm can be too fast, too slow, or affected by illness.

Sinus Tachycardia

A heart rhythm originating in the sinoatrial node with a rate faster than normal, commonly occurring as a physiologic response to exercise, fever, pain, dehydration, or stress.

Sinus X-Ray

Plain radiographic imaging of the paranasal sinuses; it has limited sensitivity and is often replaced by CT when detailed evaluation is needed.

Sipuleucel-T

A personalized cancer immunotherapy made from a patient's immune cells and used for selected advanced prostate cancers. The cells are trained to recognize a prostate-cancer target before being returned to the patient.

Sirenomelia

A rare congenital malformation in which the lower limbs are partially or completely fused. It is usually associated with severe abnormalities of the genitourinary, gastrointestinal, vascular, and spinal systems and is often fatal in the neonatal period.

Sirolimus

Sirolimus is an mTOR inhibitor used for immunosuppression after transplantation and selected vascular or lymphatic disorders; mouth ulcers, hyperlipidaemia, cytopenias, infection, impaired wound healing, and pneumonitis can occur.

Sirtuins

A family of enzymes that change other proteins and help regulate how cells use energy, respond to stress, and switch genes on or off. Their possible roles in aging and disease are still being studied.

Sisomicin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic related to gentamicin that has activity against some aerobic gram-negative bacteria; use is limited by kidney and hearing toxicity.

Sister Mary Joseph Nodule

A metastatic tumor deposit in or around the umbilicus, usually from an intra-abdominal or pelvic malignancy.

Sister Mary Joseph's Nodule

A firm, hard nodule in the umbilicus resulting from metastatic malignancy, most commonly from intra-abdominal or pelvic cancers including gastric, ovarian, and colorectal carcinoma. It indicates advanced, disseminated disease with a poor prognosis. Diagnosis is by fine needle aspiration biopsy.

Sitagliptin Phosphate

Sitagliptin phosphate is a DPP-4 inhibitor that prolongs incretin activity and improves glucose-dependent insulin secretion in type 2 diabetes; dose adjustment in kidney disease and rare pancreatitis or severe joint pain are important considerations.

Sitosterolemia

A rare inherited disorder in which the body absorbs and stores too much plant sterol, a substance found in plant foods. The buildup can cause early artery disease, skin lumps, anemia, easy bleeding, or low platelets.

Sitting Position

An upright or semiupright position in which the patient's torso is elevated and the hips and knees are flexed; it is used for selected shoulder and neurosurgical procedures.

Sit-to-Stand Postural Drift

A tendency to lose balance or move away from a stable position while standing up from a chair. It may reflect weakness, poor coordination, dizziness, or impaired balance.

Alternate Names:
Postural Instability on Rising; Chair Rise Imbalance

Situational Syncope

A reflex faint triggered by a specific situation such as coughing, urination, defecation, swallowing, laughter, or prolonged standing, caused by transient reduced cerebral perfusion.

Situs Ambiguus

A birth difference in which internal organs are arranged irregularly rather than in the usual left-right pattern. It is often associated with congenital heart defects and an absent, small, or abnormally functioning spleen.

Situs Inversus

A congenital condition in which the thoracic and abdominal organs are reversed or mirrored from their normal positions. Complete situs inversus (situs inversus totalis) involves all organs.

Situs Inversus Totalis

A congenital condition in which the major visceral organs are mirrored from their normal positions, with the liver on the left, heart on the right, and other viscera similarly reversed.

Sitz Bath

Immersion of the perineal and anal region in warm or prescribed water for symptom relief in conditions such as hemorrhoids, anal fissures, or postpartum discomfort.

SI Units

The International System of Units used for standardized measurements, including meter, kilogram, second, mole, and pascal.

Six Fingers Or Toes

Six fingers or toes is polydactyly, a congenital extra-digit difference that may occur alone or as part of a genetic syndrome.

Six-Minute Walk Test

A simple test measuring how far a person can walk in six minutes on a flat path. Clinicians record distance, symptoms, heart rate, and oxygen level to assess exercise ability and monitor heart or lung disease. Rest breaks are allowed, and the result is interpreted with other findings.

Alternate Names:
6MWT; Six-Minute Walk Distance

Sixth Disease

Alternate name; see *Roseola*.

Sixth Nerve Palsy

Dysfunction of the abducens nerve (cranial nerve VI) producing weakness or paralysis of the ipsilateral lateral rectus muscle, characterized by convergent strabismus (esotropia) and horizontal binocular diplopia worsening on gaze toward the paretic side; frequently caused by microvascular ischemia or elevated intracranial pressure.

Alternate Names:
Abducens Nerve Palsy

Size Perception

The brain's judgment of how large or small an object or body part is. Vision, touch, distance, and context all contribute; eye or brain disorders can make objects appear unusually large or small.

Sjögren Disease

A chronic autoimmune disease in which the body's immune system mistakenly attacks its own moisture-producing glands, primarily the tear glands (lacrimal glands) and salivary glands. This

causes the hallmark symptoms of severe dry eyes (which feel gritty, burning, or irritated) and dry mouth (which can cause difficulty chewing, swallowing, and speaking, along with an increased risk of dental cavities). It can occur on its own or alongside other autoimmune conditions such as rheumatoid arthritis or lupus, and may also cause fatigue, joint pain, or dryness in other parts of the body.

Alternate Names:
Sjögren's Syndrome; Sjogren Syndrome; Sicca Syndrome; Autoimmune Exocrinopathy

Sjögren Disease-Associated Arthritis

Joint pain or inflammation associated with Sjögren disease. Joint pain is more common than objective joint inflammation, so symptoms are interpreted alongside examination and other findings.

Sjogren-Larsson Syndrome

A rare autosomal recessive neurocutaneous disorder caused by mutations in the ALDH3A2 gene encoding fatty aldehyde dehydrogenase (FALDH), characterized by the clinical triad of congenital ichthyosis, spastic diplegia or tetraplegia, and severe intellectual disability with retinal glistening white dots.

Alternate Names:
SLS; Fatty Aldehyde Dehydrogenase Deficiency

Sjögrenś Disease

Alternate name; see *Sjögren Disease*.

Sjogren's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sjögren Disease*.

SjöGren's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sjögren Disease*.

Sjogren Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sjögren Disease*.

SjöGren Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sjögren Disease*.

SJS

Alternate name; see *Stevens-Johnson Syndrome*.

Skeletal Development

Skeletal development is formation, growth, remodeling, and maturation of bones and cartilage from embryonic life through adulthood.

Skeletal Dysplasia

An inherited disorder of bone or cartilage development that may cause short or uneven growth, unusually shaped limbs, spine problems, or other differences in the skeleton. Effects vary widely between conditions.

Skeletal Limb Abnormalities

Skeletal limb abnormalities are differences in the formation, length, alignment, or structure of an arm or leg caused by genetic, developmental, vascular, injury, or other factors.

Skeletal Muscle

A type of voluntary, striated muscle tissue anchored to the skeleton via collagenous tendons that contracts to generate joint movement, maintain posture, and produce thermogenic heat. Composed of multinucleated, cylindrical muscle fibers containing highly organized myofibrils divided into repeating sarcomeres (the functional contractile unit, bounded by Z-discs and comprising interdigitating actin thin filaments and myosin thick filaments); contraction is triggered by acetylcholine release at neuromuscular junctions and mediated by calcium-troponin-tropomyosin cross-bridge cycling.

Alternate Names:
Skeletal Muscles; Striated Muscle; Voluntary Muscle

Skeletal Muscles

Plural form; see *Skeletal Muscle*.

Skeletal Muscle Tissue

Voluntary striated muscle attached to bones or other structures, composed of contractile fibers that generate movement, posture, heat, and joint stability.

Skeletal Myocytes

Skeletal myocytes are striated muscle cells responsible for voluntary movement, posture, heat produc-

tion, and stabilization of joints.

Skeletal Survey

A set of X-rays of most of a child's bones, used especially when multiple injuries or a medical condition affecting bone development is suspected. It can show fractures, bone abnormalities, and signs of healing; imaging alone does not establish their cause.

Skeletal System

The skeletal system consists of bones, cartilage, joints, and supporting ligaments that provide structure, protect organs, enable movement, and store minerals.

Skeletal X-Ray

A skeletal X-ray series uses radiographs of selected bones and joints to evaluate fractures, alignment, bone density patterns, arthritis, infection, tumors, and developmental abnormalities.

Skeleton

The body's framework of bones and cartilage that supports movement and protects organs. It also stores minerals, contains marrow that makes blood cells, and provides attachment points for muscles and ligaments.

Skeletonization

Final stage of postmortem decomposition where soft tissues, organs, and skin have completely decayed or been scavenged, leaving only clean osseous skeletal remains.

Skene Gland Cyst

A fluid-filled sac that forms when a Skene gland, also called a paraurethral gland, becomes blocked. These glands are located beside the opening of the urethra. Small cysts may cause no symptoms. Larger or infected cysts may cause pain, painful urination, difficulty passing urine, pain during sex, recurrent urinary infections, or an abscess. Diagnosis is usually made by pelvic examination. Symptomatic cysts may need surgical removal or marsupialization.

Skilled Nursing Facility

A facility where people receive 24-hour nursing care and rehabilitation after illness, injury, surgery, or a hospital stay. Care may include wound care, medicines, injections, therapy, and help with daily activities until the person can return home or move to another setting.

Skilled Nursing Or Rehabilitation Facilities

Facilities that provide 24-hour nursing care, rehabilitation, medication management, and assistance with daily activities after illness, injury, surgery, or functional decline.

Skin

The body's outer covering, consisting mainly of the epidermis and dermis with appendages such as hair, nails, and glands. It protects against injury, infection, ultraviolet light, and water loss; detects touch, pressure, pain, and temperature; helps regulate body temperature; and contributes to immune defense and vitamin D production.

Skin Abscess

A painful, swollen pocket of pus under the skin, usually caused by a bacterial infection. It may need drainage and antibiotics.

Skin Absorption

Movement of a substance through the skin into underlying tissues or the bloodstream. Absorption depends on the substance, skin condition, contact time, and exposed area.

Skin Aging

Natural aging and long-term sun exposure gradually thin and dry the skin, reduce elasticity, slow healing, and cause wrinkles or dark spots. Limiting ultraviolet exposure, using protective clothing, and applying broad-spectrum sunscreen can reduce further damage.

Skin Aging And Appearance

Skin aging is a complex biological process influenced by both intrinsic factors, such as genetics and

natural aging, and extrinsic factors, particularly ultraviolet radiation exposure.

Skin Allergies And Contact Dermatitis

Inflammatory skin reactions triggered by exposure to allergens or irritants that come into direct contact with the skin.

Skin Allergy Testing

Tests in which small amounts of suspected allergens are placed on or just under the skin and the reaction is observed. They can show sensitization to foods, medicines, venoms, or environmental allergens; a positive result does not by itself establish clinical allergy.

Skin And Aging

Skin aging involves intrinsic and extrinsic changes. Intrinsic aging causes thinning, wrinkling, and fragility. Extrinsic (photo)aging causes wrinkles, telangiectasias, lentigines, and actinic keratoses. Collagen loss, elastin degradation, and decreased cell turnover contribute to aging skin.

Skin And Environment

Environmental factors significantly affect skin health. Pollution causes oxidative stress, inflammation, and accelerated aging. Particulate matter penetrates skin, generating free radicals. Blue light from screens causes hyperpigmentation, particularly in darker skin tones. Indoor heating and air conditioning cause dryness.

Skin Appendages

Structures that grow from or lie within the skin, including hair follicles, oil glands, and sweat glands. They help lubricate and cool the body and can be affected by acne, infection, inflammation, or inherited disorders.

Skin Barrier

Alternate term; see *Skin Barrier Function*.

Skin Barrier Function

The outer skin barrier limits water loss and helps keep out irritants, allergens, and germs. Its tightly packed surface cells and natural oils maintain protection; injury or inflammation can make skin dry, cracked, and more vulnerable.

Skin Biopsy

Removal of a small skin sample for examination under a microscope. It can help diagnose skin cancer, infection, inflammatory disease, blistering disease, or an unexplained rash; the method depends on the lesion.

Skin Biopsy Methods

The sampling method is chosen according to the lesion's appearance and depth. A punch takes a round full-thickness sample, a shave removes a superficial layer, and an excision removes the whole lesion when complete removal is appropriate.

Skin Biopsy Techniques

Skin biopsy is selected according to the suspected diagnosis and lesion depth. Punch biopsy samples full-thickness skin; shave biopsy samples superficial lesions; excisional biopsy removes an entire small lesion; and incisional biopsy samples part of a large lesion.

Skin Blushing/Flushing

Temporary reddening or warming of the skin caused by widening of small blood vessels. It may result from heat, emotion, exercise, fever, medicines, or hormone changes.

Skin Cancer

Cancer that begins in cells of the skin. Common types include basal cell carcinoma, squamous cell carcinoma, and melanoma; less common types arise from other skin structures. Risk is influenced by ultraviolet exposure, immune suppression, genetic susceptibility, and certain preexisting lesions. A skin cancer may appear as a changing, bleeding, growing, scaly, or nonhealing spot.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Malignancy

Skin Cancer Epidemiology

Skin cancers are common and include basal-cell carcinoma, squamous-cell carcinoma, and melanoma. Incidence and mortality vary by tumor type, geography, skin phenotype, ultraviolet exposure, immune status, and access to diagnosis and treatment.

Skin Cancer Reconstruction

Reconstructive repair of a defect after removal of skin cancer. Depending on the size, depth, and location, repair may use direct closure, a skin graft, a local or regional flap, or free tissue transfer to restore protection, function, and appearance.

Skin Cancer Screening

Examination of the skin for new or changing spots, especially in people at increased risk. Clinicians may use a full-body examination, a magnifying instrument, or a biopsy; routine screening recommendations vary by individual risk.

Skin Cancer Staging

Determining how far a skin cancer has grown or spread to guide treatment and estimate outlook. For melanoma, staging considers tumor thickness and ulceration, lymph-node involvement, and spread to distant sites; the exact system depends on cancer type.

Skin Cancer Surgery

Surgery to remove skin cancer with a margin of apparently healthy tissue. The method depends on the cancer type, size, location, and spread and may include standard excision or Mohs surgery, which checks the edges during removal.

Skin Carcinoma

Cancer arising from skin cells, most commonly basal-cell or squamous-cell carcinoma. It may appear as a changing sore, lump, scaly patch, or wound that does not heal and needs examination.

Skin Care

Measures that protect and maintain the skin, including gentle cleansing, moisturization, sun protection, wound care, avoidance of irritants, and treatment of identified disease.

Skin Care And Incontinence

Skin protection for people with urine or stool leakage, including gentle cleansing, thorough drying, absorbent products, barrier creams, regular changing, and treatment of the underlying cause.

Skin Cells

Skin cells form the layers of the skin and include keratinocytes, melanocytes, immune cells, and sensory cells. They provide protection, pigmentation, sensation, and repair.

Skin Color

The visible color of skin, determined mainly by melanin, blood flow, oxygenation, and other pigments.

Skin Culture

Laboratory testing of a swab, scraping, fluid, or tissue sample from the skin to identify bacteria, fungi, or other organisms causing infection.

Skin Cyst

A closed sac under or within the skin, often filled with fluid, keratin, or other material. Many are harmless; pain, infection, or change in size or appearance may occur.

Skin Diseases

Conditions affecting skin, hair, nails, glands, or subcutaneous tissue, including infection, inflammation, neoplasia, and genetic disorders.

Skin Erosion

A shallow loss of the epidermis that leaves a moist or crusted surface but does not extend deeply into the dermis, often caused by friction, scratching, blister rupture, or inflammation.

Skin Examination

Systematic inspection and palpation of the skin, hair, nails, and mucous membranes to assess color, lesions, texture, distribution, vascular signs, infec-

tion, and cancer warning features.

Skin Findings In Newborns

Common skin changes in newborns, such as milia, newborn rash, peeling, birthmarks, or bluish hands and feet. Most are harmless; fever, blisters, widespread redness, or an ill appearance can signal infection or another serious condition.

Skin Flaps

Pieces of skin and underlying tissue moved to cover a wound while keeping or reconnecting their blood supply. Flaps may come from nearby tissue or another part of the body and are used after injury, cancer removal, or reconstructive surgery.

Skin Graft

Skin taken from one area of the body and placed over a wound, burn, ulcer, or surgical defect. A graft must obtain blood from the wound surface to survive and may fail, scar, change color, or require further surgery.

Alternate Names:
Skin Grafting

Skin Grafting

Unhyphenated variant; see *Skin-Grafting*.

Skin-Grafting

Surgery that moves skin from a donor area to cover a wound, burn, ulcer, or tissue defect. The graft needs blood supply from the wound bed and may fail, scar, or change color.

Skin Immune System

The cells and protective substances in skin that recognize germs, remove damaged cells, and control inflammation. It works with the skin barrier to prevent infection and support healing after injury.

Skin Induration

Unusual hardness or firmness of the skin or tissue beneath it. Causes include scar formation, inflammation, swelling, infection, an infiltrating disease, or a growth; examination determines the cause.

Skin Infection

Infection of the skin or underlying soft tissue, commonly caused by bacteria, fungi, or viruses. Redness, warmth, swelling, pain, drainage, or fever may occur; rapidly spreading redness, severe pain, blisters, or systemic illness can indicate deep or spreading infection.

Skin Integrity

The condition of skin and underlying tissue when it remains intact and protected from injury. Prolonged pressure, friction, moisture, poor blood flow, and illness can cause breakdown, especially over bony areas.

Skin Irritation

Inflammation or discomfort caused by direct contact with an irritant, often producing redness, burning, itching, dryness, or scaling.

Skin Lesion

An abnormal area of skin that may result from infection, inflammation, injury, allergy, or a benign or malignant growth.

Skin Lesion Aspiration

Removal of fluid or cells from a skin lump with a needle for testing or drainage.

Skin Lesion Biopsy

Removal of part or all of a skin lesion for microscopic examination to diagnose infection, inflammatory disease, benign tumor, or skin cancer.

Skin Lesion KOH Exam

Microscopic examination of skin scrapings treated with potassium hydroxide to detect fungal hyphae or yeast in suspected superficial fungal infection.

Skin Lesion Of Blastomycosis

A blastomycosis skin lesion results from dissemination of Blastomyces fungal infection and may appear as verrucous or ulcerated lesions with raised borders.

Skin Lesion Removal

Removal of an unwanted, suspicious, or diseased area of skin by shaving, cutting, freezing, scraping, or another method. Tissue may be sent for laboratory examination; bleeding, infection, scarring, and incomplete removal are possible.

Skin Lumps

Skin lumps are localized bumps or masses caused by cysts, lipomas, inflamed follicles, infections, benign tumors, or less commonly cancer; persistence or change warrants assessment.

Skin Mastocytoma

A localized collection of mast cells in the skin, usually a yellow-brown or reddish plaque or nodule in a child that may swell, itch, or redden when rubbed.

Skin Microbiome

The community of bacteria, fungi, viruses, and other microorganisms normally living on the skin. They interact with the skin and immune system; changes in this community may contribute to some skin diseases.

Skin Mycosis

A fungal infection of the skin, hair, or nails, also called cutaneous mycosis or dermatomycosis. It may be superficial or extend deeper into the skin and can cause scaling, itching, inflammation, discoloration, or lesions; diagnosis depends on the appearance and, when needed, microscopy or culture.

Skin Necrosis

Death of skin tissue from ischemia, infection, pressure, toxins, trauma, vasculitis, or severe inflammation, producing discoloration, blisters, ulcers, or black eschar.

Skin Neoplasm

A skin neoplasm is an abnormal growth in the skin that may be benign, precancerous, or malignant.

Skin Nodules

Firm, raised lumps in or under the skin. They may result from inflammation, infection, injury, cysts, or benign or malignant growths.

Skin Of Color

A broad term for people with more deeply pigmented skin. Some conditions may appear differently, and dark marks or raised scars may develop more readily after inflammation or injury; skin cancer can occur in every skin tone.

Skin Or Nail Culture

Laboratory culture of skin, hair, or nail material to identify bacteria or fungi when infection is suspected; results require clinical correlation.

Skin Pigmentation

Skin color is produced mainly by melanin made by pigment-producing cells. Sun exposure, hormones, inflammation, medicines, and illness can make areas darker or lighter; new or changing discoloration may reflect a developing skin condition.

Skin Rash

A visible change in the skin, such as redness, scaling, bumps, blisters, or discoloration. Causes include infection, allergy, inflammation, medicines, heat, and systemic disease; rapid spread, skin pain, blistering, fever, or mucosal involvement can signal serious illness.

Skin Resurfacing

Procedures that improve skin texture, scars, wrinkles, or uneven color by removing or changing surface skin layers. Methods include lasers, chemical peels, and abrasion; risks include infection, pigment changes, and scarring.

Skin Scraping

Removal of a small amount of surface skin scale or material for laboratory examination, commonly to look for fungi, mites, or other causes of a rash.

Skin Self-Exam

A person's own inspection of the skin for new or changing moles, sores, lumps, or patches.

Skin Tag

A benign, pedunculated cutaneous polypoid growth composed of a core of loose fibrovascular tissue covered by normal epidermis. Commonly arising in intertriginous skin folds where friction occurs (such as the neck, axillae, inframammary creases, and groin), skin tags are strongly correlated with advancing age, obesity, insulin resistance, metabolic syndrome, and pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Skin Tags; Acrochordon; Fibroepithelial Polyp

Skin Tags

Plural form; see *Skin Tag*.

Skin Test

A test that uses the skin's response to help diagnose a condition. Examples include allergy prick or patch tests and the tuberculin skin test for tuberculosis infection; the method and meaning depend on the test.

Skin Turgor

The skin's ability to return to its normal position after being gently pinched. Reduced turgor may occur with dehydration, although it is less reliable in older adults.

Skin Writing

A skin condition in which light scratching or pressure causes temporary raised red lines or welts.

Skipped Heartbeats

Alternate name; see *Palpitation*.

Skull

The bony framework of the head that protects the brain and supports the face, eyes, ears, and jaw.

Skull Fracture

A break in one or more skull bones caused by trauma. It may occur with bleeding inside the skull, brain injury, or leakage of clear fluid from the nose or ear.

Skull X-Ray

A skull X-ray uses low-dose radiation to show skull bones and may help assess selected fractures, foreign bodies, or bone abnormalities.

Slanted Ear

An ear whose upper edge slopes unusually compared with typical ear orientation; it may be isolated or part of a genetic condition.

SLAP Lesion

A tear in the upper rim of the shoulder socket, sometimes where the biceps tendon attaches. It may follow a fall, lifting injury, or repeated overhead activity and can cause pain, clicking, weakness, or instability.

Slapped Cheek Disease

Alternate name; see *Parvovirus Infection*.

Slapped Cheek Syndrome

Erythema infectiosum, a parvovirus B19 infection causing a slapped-cheek rash and sometimes joint or hematologic complications.

SLAP Tears

Tears of the superior glenoid labrum extending from anterior to posterior, sometimes involving the biceps tendon attachment. They may cause pain, clicking, or instability, especially with overhead activity.

SLE

Systemic lupus erythematosus, a chronic autoimmune disease that can affect skin, joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, and other organs.

Sleep

A naturally recurring state in which awareness and responses to the surroundings decrease while the brain and body follow organized patterns. Sleep supports learning, memory, emotional health, physical recovery, immune function, and metabolism.

Alternate Names:
Slumber

Sleep Apnea

Repeated pauses or reductions in breathing during sleep. It can result from the airway closing, the brain failing to signal breathing, or both, and may cause loud snoring, gasping, poor sleep, daytime sleepiness, and low oxygen.

Sleep Apnoea

Alternate name; see *Sleep Apnea*.

Sleep Architecture

The pattern and order of sleep stages during a night or other sleep period. It includes lighter sleep, deep sleep, and dream-related REM sleep; illness, medicines, age, stress, and sleep disorders can change how much time is spent in each stage.

Sleep Bruxism

Repeated grinding or clenching of the teeth during sleep, which may cause tooth wear, jaw pain, or headaches.

Sleep Debt

The accumulated difference between the amount of sleep a person needs and the amount obtained over time; it may impair alertness, mood, cognition, and performance.

Sleep Diary

A daily record of sleep and wake times, awakenings, naps, medicines, caffeine, and related factors used to assess sleep patterns and treatment response.

Sleep Disorder

A broad medical or psychiatric condition characterized by disturbances in sleep quality, timing, architecture, or duration, or by abnormal physiological events occurring during sleep or sleep-wake transitions. Major classifications include insomnias, sleep-related breathing disorders (obstructive and central sleep apnea), central disorders of hypersomnolence (narcolepsy, idiopathic hypersomnia), circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorders, parasomnias (NREM and REM sleep parasomnias), and sleep-related movement disorders (restless legs syndrome). Diagnosis is supported by polysomnography and actigraphy.

Alternate Names:
Sleep Disorders; Somnipathy

Sleep Disorders

Plural form; see *Sleep Disorder*.

Sleep Disorders in Children

Children and teens need age-appropriate sleep, and disorders may involve insomnia, circadian delay, sleep apnea, parasomnias, restless legs, or insufficient opportunity. Snoring, pauses in breathing, unusual daytime sleepiness, mood change, or poor school performance warrants evaluation.

Sleep Disorders In Older Adults

Sleep problems in later life, including insomnia, sleep apnea, restless legs, and circadian changes; contributing factors include medicine effects, pain, depression, and medical illness.

Sleep Efficiency

The percentage of time in bed that a person is actually asleep. It is calculated by dividing total sleep time by time in bed; a low value may occur with insomnia, repeated awakenings, or other sleep disorders.

Sleep Epilepsy

Epilepsy in which seizures occur predominantly during sleep or transitions between sleep and wakefulness. Events may be subtle or involve movements, vocalizations, confusion, or injury and require neurologic evaluation.

Sleep Fragmentation

Repeated brief awakenings or partial arousals that interrupt otherwise continuous sleep. It can reduce restorative sleep and occur with sleep apnea, pain, noise, movement disorders, medicines, or illness.

Sleep Hygiene

Habits and surroundings that support regular, restorative sleep. Helpful measures include a consistent schedule, a dark and quiet bedroom, relaxing

before bed, and limiting caffeine, alcohol, nicotine, and stimulating screen use near bedtime.

Sleep Terror Disorder

A non-rapid eye movement (NREM) sleep parasomnia characterized by abrupt awakenings with panicky screams, intense autonomic arousal, and motor agitation; see *Night Terrors*.

Sleeping Sickness

Alternate name; see *Human African Trypanosomiasis*.

Sleeplessness

Alternate lay term; see *Insomnia Disorder*.

Sleep Medicine

The medical specialty focused on disorders of sleep and wakefulness. It includes insomnia, sleep-related breathing disorders, narcolepsy and other hypersomnolence disorders, circadian rhythm disorders, parasomnias, and sleep-related movement disorders; evaluation may involve sleep history and physiologic testing.

Sleep Onset Latency

The time required to fall asleep after attempting to sleep; prolonged latency may occur with insomnia, anxiety, circadian misalignment, stimulants, or another sleep disorder.

Sleep Paralysis

Temporary inability to move or speak when falling asleep or waking, while awareness is partly or fully preserved. Episodes usually last seconds to minutes and may include frightening hallucinations. Recurrent episodes can be associated with sleep deprivation, irregular sleep, narcolepsy, or other sleep disorders.

Sleep Related Breathing Disorders

Sleep-related breathing disorders cause abnormal ventilation or oxygenation during sleep, including obstructive and central sleep apnea and sleep-related hypoventilation. Snoring, witnessed pauses, gasping, morning headache, or daytime sleepiness may prompt sleep testing and treatment.

Alternate Names:
Sleep-Disordered Breathing; SDB

Sleep-Related Hypoventilation

Breathing that is too shallow during sleep to remove enough carbon dioxide or maintain normal oxygen. It can result from obesity, lung or muscle disease, chest-wall problems, brain disorders, or sedating medicines.

Sleep-Related Hypoxemia

Abnormally low blood oxygen during sleep that may occur with sleep-disordered breathing, lung disease, neuromuscular weakness, hypoventilation, or other medical conditions.

Sleep Spindles

Short bursts of regular brain activity that occur mainly during stage 2 non-REM sleep. They are seen on a sleep recording and are thought to help protect sleep and process newly learned information.

Sleep Study

A comprehensive overnight diagnostic sleep recording that monitors brain waves, oxygen saturation, heart rhythm, and respirations; see *Polysomnography*.

Sleep Studies

Overnight tests that record brain activity, eye movements, heart rate, breathing, blood oxygen, body position, and limb movements. They help identify sleep apnea, unusual movements, seizures during sleep, and other sleep disorders.

Alternate Names:
Sleep Diagnostic Study; Nocturnal Somnography

Sleepwalking

Recurrent walking or other complex behavior during sleep, usually with little memory afterward. It is more common in children and may be triggered by sleep deprivation, stress, fever, medicines, or other sleep disorders; injury prevention is important.

Sleepwalking And Children

Sleepwalking in children is usually benign and often resolves with age; regular sleep, hazard prevention, and evaluation of frequent, violent, injurious, or atypical episodes are important.

Sleepwalking Disorder

A sleep disorder involving repeated episodes of walking or other complex behavior during sleep, usually with little memory afterward, that cause injury, distress, sleep disruption, or impaired daytime functioning.

Sleeve Gastrectomy

An operation that removes most of the stomach, leaving a narrow sleeve-shaped section. It limits how much food the stomach can hold and changes appetite hormones; bleeding, leakage, reflux, and nutritional problems can occur.

Sleeve Lobectomy

An operation that removes a lung lobe and the nearby affected part of the main breathing tube, then reconnects the remaining airway. It can remove a centrally located tumor while preserving more healthy lung than removing the whole lung. Possible complications include air leakage, narrowing of the airway, infection, and bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Bronchial Sleeve Resection; Sleeve Resection of the Lung

Sliding Filament

The process by which muscles contract: two protein fibers slide past each other, shortening the muscle's working units. Calcium and energy from ATP allow the fibers to attach, pull, release, and repeat the cycle.

Sliding Hiatal Hernia

A sliding hiatal hernia occurs when the stomach and gastroesophageal junction move upward through the diaphragm, often contributing to reflux.

Sling

A supportive device or surgically placed strip used to support an injured limb or urinary structures.

Slipped Capital Femoral Epiphysis

A hip problem in growing children or teenagers in which the upper end of the thigh bone slips through its growth area. It may cause hip, groin, thigh, or knee pain and a limp; continued slipping can damage the hip joint and its blood supply.

Alternate Names:
SCFE

Slipped Disc

A common lay term for a herniated or prolapsed intervertebral disk, in which disk material extends beyond its normal boundary and may irritate a nearby nerve, causing back or neck pain, numbness, or weakness.

Slipped Disk

A spinal disk whose tough outer layer tears or weakens, allowing its inner material to bulge and irritate nearby nerves. It may cause back or neck pain, numbness, weakness, or sciatica.

Alternate Names:
Herniated Disc; Intervertebral Disc Prolapse

Slipped Vertebra

Forward movement of one spinal bone compared with the bone below it, also called spondylolisthesis. It may cause back pain, stiffness, hamstring tightness, or pressure on a nerve, although some people have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Spondylolisthesis

Slipping Rib Syndrome

Pain caused by excessive movement of the lower ribs, usually from loosened cartilage. The pain may be sharp and can sometimes be reproduced by pressing or moving the rib.

Slit Lamp

An eye-examination microscope that uses magnifica-

tion and a narrow beam of light to inspect the eyelids, cornea, lens, and other eye structures. It helps detect infection, injury, cataract, and glaucoma-related changes.

Alternate Names:
Biomicroscope

Slit-Lamp Biomicroscope

Alternate name; see *Slit Lamp*.

Slit Lamp Biomicroscopy

A detailed eye examination using a bright, narrow beam of light and a microscope to view the front of the eye. Additional lenses can help examine the retina and other structures farther back.

Slit-Lamp Exam

Alternate name; see *Slit Lamp Biomicroscopy*.

Slit Lamp Examination

A fundamental ophthalmological diagnostic procedure utilizing a specialized high-intensity light source focused through a slit aperture paired with a binocular biomicroscope to examine the anterior segment of the eye (cornea, anterior chamber, iris, crystalline lens) and vitreous under high magnification.

Alternate Names:
Biomicroscopy

Slit-Lamp Examination

A diagnostic ophthalmologic procedure utilizing a binocular biomicroscope paired with an adjustable, high-intensity slit-beam light source, allowing detailed optical sectioning and high-magnification stereoscopic examination of the eyelids, cornea, anterior chamber, iris, lens, and anterior vitreous.

Alternate Names:
Slit-Lamp Biomicroscopy; Anterior Segment Biomicroscopy

SLL

Alternate name; see *Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma*.

Slough

Soft, dead, or detached tissue covering or separating from a wound, ulcer, or inflamed surface. It can delay healing and may need gentle removal after blood flow, infection, and the wound's depth are assessed.

Slowed or Arrested Breathing

Pathologic depression of the respiratory rate (bradypnea) or complete cessation of ventilatory airflow (apnea), resulting from central nervous system depression, drug toxicity (such as opioid overdose), traumatic brain injury, upper airway obstruction, or terminal cardiopulmonary arrest requiring emergent airway management and resuscitation.

Alternate Names:
Bradypnea; Apnea; Respiratory Arrest; Hypopnea

Slow Heartbeat

Alternate name; see *Bradycardia*.

Slow Heart Rate

A heart rate slower than expected, often below 60 beats per minute in an adult. It may be normal in some people but can cause dizziness, fainting, tiredness, or shortness of breath when it reduces blood flow.

Slow-Twitch Fiber

A type of muscle fiber suited to steady activity over a long time. It uses oxygen efficiently and resists tiredness, helping with posture, walking, and endurance activities rather than short bursts of maximum force.

Alternate Names:
Type I Muscle Fiber; Red Muscle Fiber

Slow-Wave Sleep

The deepest stage of non-REM sleep, marked by slow brain waves and reduced response to sounds or touch. It supports physical recovery, memory, and hormone release and is often reduced by ageing, illness, alcohol, or sleep disruption.

Alternate Names:
Deep Sleep; Delta Sleep; Stage N3 Sleep

Small Airway Disease

Narrowing, inflammation, or blockage of the smallest breathing tubes in the lungs. It may cause cough, wheezing, breathlessness, or trapped air and can occur with asthma, COPD, infection, or other lung disease.

Small Bowel Adenocarcinoma

A malignant gland-forming epithelial tumor of the small intestine. It is uncommon and may cause occult bleeding, obstruction, abdominal pain, or weight loss; risk is increased in selected inherited and inflammatory disorders.

Small Bowel Bacterial Overgrowth

An abnormal increase in bacteria in the small intestine, where bacterial numbers are normally lower than in the large intestine. It can cause bloating, abdominal discomfort, diarrhea, weight loss, or poor nutrient absorption. Methane-producing archaea are addressed separately as intestinal methanogen overgrowth.

Small Bowel Bleeding

Bleeding from the small intestine. It may cause black or maroon stool, hidden blood loss, or iron-deficiency anemia and may require capsule endoscopy, enteroscopy, imaging, or other tests to find the source.

Small Bowel Follow-Through

A series of X-rays taken after swallowing contrast, usually barium, to follow its movement through the small intestine. It can show narrowing, obstruction, inflammation, or abnormal transit.

Small Bowel Obstruction

A partial or complete blockage that stops food, liquid, or gas from moving through the small intestine. It may result from scar tissue, a hernia, a tumor, or narrowing from inflammation. It can cause belly pain, swelling, vomiting, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Small-Bowel Obstruction

Alternate spelling; see *Small Bowel Obstruction*.

Small Bowel Prolapse

Alternate name; see *Enterocele*.

Small Bowel Resection

Surgical removal of a diseased segment of the small intestine followed by reconnection or stoma formation when needed.

Small Bowel Series

A series of X-ray images of the small intestine after swallowing contrast material, usually barium. It can show narrowing, blockage, abnormal movement, inflammation, tumors, or changes from Crohn disease.

Small Bowel Tissue Smear/Biopsy

Examination of cells or a tissue sample from the small intestine to investigate poor nutrient absorption, celiac disease, inflammation, infection, or a tumor.

Small-Bowel Transplantation

Surgery replacing a severely diseased or nonfunctioning small intestine with donor bowel. It may help people unable to receive enough nutrition through the gut but requires lifelong rejection-preventing medicines and monitoring.

Small-Bowel Volvulus

Twisting of the small intestine that can block its contents and cut off its blood supply. It may cause severe abdominal pain, vomiting, swelling, and inability to pass stool or gas.

Small Calorie

A small calorie is a unit of heat energy; food labels usually use a kilocalorie, written Calorie with a capital C, equal to 1,000 small calories.

Small Cell Carcinoma

A fast-growing cancer made of small cells, most often beginning in the lung and strongly linked to smoking. It may shrink at first with treatment but often returns or spreads early, including to the brain.

Small-Cell Carcinoma

A fast-growing cancer, most often starting in the lung and strongly linked with smoking. It may shrink quickly with chemotherapy or radiation but often returns or spreads early, including to the brain.

Small Cell Lung Cancer

An aggressive lung cancer strongly associated with smoking and early spread. It often responds initially to chemotherapy or radiation, but recurrence is common and treatment depends on the stage and overall health.

Small Cell Lung Carcinoma

An aggressive, high-grade neuroendocrine malignancy of the lung strongly linked to heavy cigarette smoking, characterized histologically by small sheets of cells with scant cytoplasm, granular nuclear chromatin ("salt-and-pepper"), absence of nucleoli, high mitotic rates, and frequent paraneoplastic syndromes (SIADH, Lambert-Eaton).

Alternate Names:
SCLC

Small Eye

An eye that is smaller than usual because it did not develop fully before birth. Vision may be reduced, especially when other eye structures are also affected, and assessment can identify associated conditions.

Small Fiber Neuropathy

Damage to tiny nerves that carry pain, temperature, and automatic body signals. It can cause burning feet, tingling, poor temperature sensation, abnormal sweating, digestive symptoms, or heart-rate changes; diabetes is one possible cause.

Small For Gestational Age

Birth weight or size below the expected range for gestational age, caused by constitutional small size, placental insufficiency, infection, genetic disease, or maternal factors.

Small Incision Lenticule Extraction

Surgery

Small incision lenticule extraction, or SMILE, is a laser eye procedure that removes a small piece of corneal tissue through a tiny incision to correct some cases of nearsightedness and astigmatism.

Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth

An abnormal increase or change in bacteria within the small intestine, often causing bloating, abdominal pain, nausea, diarrhea, fullness, weight loss, or nutrient deficiency. Causes include impaired intestinal movement, structural problems, surgery, and some systemic diseases; these symptoms also occur in other conditions.

Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth (SIBO)

Alternate name; see *Small Intestinal Bacterial Overgrowth*.

Small-Intestinal Cancer

Malignant tumors arising in the small intestine, classified mainly as adenocarcinoma, neuroendocrine tumors, lymphomas, or sarcomas. They are far less common than colorectal cancer and often present late with vague abdominal pain, bleeding, obstruction, or weight loss; risk is increased in some inherited syndromes, celiac disease, and Crohn disease. Diagnosis uses endoscopy, capsule endoscopy, or imaging, and treatment depends on the tumor type and stage.

Small Intestinal Fungal Overgrowth

A proposed condition in which excess fungi are found in the small intestine and may be associated with bloating, nausea, diarrhea, or abdominal discomfort. Symptoms are nonspecific and testing is not standardized, so the condition remains uncertain.

Small Intestinal Ischemia And Infarction

Inadequate blood supply to the small intestine that can progress to irreversible tissue death, perforation, sepsis, and shock.

Small Intestinal Mucosa

The inner lining of the small intestine. Its folds, villi,

and microvilli greatly increase the area available for digestion and nutrient absorption.

Small Intestine

The long, coiled part of the digestive tract between the stomach and large intestine. It receives bile and pancreatic juices, completes digestion, and absorbs most nutrients and much of the body's water.

Small Intestine Aspirate And Culture

Collection and culture of fluid aspirated from the small intestine to evaluate suspected bacterial overgrowth or selected infections; the procedure is invasive and results require clinical correlation.

Small Intestine Cancer

A malignant tumor arising in the small intestine. Types include adenocarcinoma, neuroendocrine tumor, lymphoma, and sarcoma; symptoms and treatment depend on the tumor type and extent.

Small Intestine Prolapse

Alternate name; see *Enterocele*.

Small Lymphocytic Lymphoma

A usually slow-growing B-cell non-Hodgkin lymphoma that is closely related to chronic lymphocytic leukemia. It commonly causes enlarged lymph nodes and is diagnosed with tissue examination and immunophenotyping.

Smallpox

A severe contagious disease caused by variola virus, producing fever and rash; global eradication was certified in 1980.

Small Round Blue Cell Tumor

A tumor whose cells look small, round, and blue under a microscope. This appearance occurs in several cancers, especially in children, so additional tissue tests are needed to identify the exact type.

Small Saphenous Vein

A superficial vein running up the back of the calf and usually joining the popliteal vein behind the knee. It helps return blood from the foot and calf to the heart.

Small Vessel Disease

Disease affecting small blood vessels, which can impair blood flow and contribute to brain, heart, kidney, or other organ problems. The specific term depends on the affected organ and cause.

Small-Vessel Vasculitis

A group of diseases that inflame small blood vessels and can affect the skin or internal organs. Skin involvement may cause raised purple spots, blisters, or ulcers; other symptoms depend on the organs involved. Leukocytoclastic vasculitis is a common biopsy pattern in skin-limited small-vessel vasculitis, but the terms are not interchangeable in every case.

SMART

A way to set goals that are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-limited. SMART goals state exactly what is wanted, how progress will be checked, and when the goal should be reached.

Alternate Names:
SMART Criteria; Specific Measurable Goals

Smashed Fingers

A finger injury caused by crushing, which may damage skin, nail, bone, tendon, or nerve. Deformity, severe pain, numbness, impaired movement, or blood under the nail can accompany a fracture or significant tissue injury.

Smear Of Duodenal Fluid Aspirate

A smear of duodenal fluid aspirate examines fluid from the first part of the small intestine for selected parasites or other microscopic findings.

Smegma

A buildup of shed skin cells, skin oils, and moisture in genital folds, including beneath the foreskin. It is a normal body material and can be removed with gentle washing.

Smell

The sense of detecting airborne chemicals through receptors in the nasal lining and processing the signals in the brain. Reduced or lost smell can follow infection, nasal disease, head injury, medicines, or neurologic disease.

SMILE

A laser eye operation that corrects short-sightedness and some short-sighted astigmatism. The laser creates a thin piece of tissue inside the cornea, which is removed through a small opening without making a larger corneal flap.

Smile Design

Planning smile based on facial features, gum display, tooth proportions. Digital smile design software available.

Smith Fracture

An extra-articular fracture of the distal radius with volar (palmar) displacement and angulation of the distal fracture fragment ('reverse Colles fracture'), typically caused by a direct fall onto a flexed wrist.

Alternate Names:
Reverse Colles Fracture; Volar Distal Radius Fracture

Smith-Lemli-Opitz Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder affecting cholesterol production before birth. It may cause growth and developmental problems, distinctive facial features, heart or limb abnormalities, feeding difficulty, and genital differences.

Smith-Magenis Syndrome

A genetic neurodevelopmental disorder, usually involving deletion of 17p11.2 or an RAI1 variant. It causes developmental delay, intellectual disability, distinctive facial features, sleep disturbance, behavioral dysregulation, and variable congenital abnormalities.

Smoke Evacuator

A device that captures and filters smoke produced during surgery by electrical, laser, or ultrasonic instruments. Removing the plume reduces staff and patient exposure to particles, irritating gases, and potentially infectious material.

Smoke Inhalation

Injury from breathing smoke, hot gases, or combustion products, potentially causing airway burns, poisoning, and lung injury.

Smoke Inhalation Injury

Pulmonary injury caused by inhalation of toxic products of combustion.

Smokeless Tobacco

Smokeless tobacco delivers nicotine and causes dependence, oral lesions, gum recession, tooth loss, cardiovascular risk, and cancers of the mouth, throat, and pancreas. Quitting reduces harm, and counseling plus approved medicines improve cessation success.

Alternate Names:
Chewing Tobacco; Snuff; Dip

Smoker Keratosis

Alternate name; see *Leukoplakia*.

Smoker Lung

Alternate name; see *Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease*.

Smoking

Inhalation of smoke from burning tobacco or other substances, associated with addiction, cancer, cardiovascular disease, and lung disease.

Smoking And Asthma

Smoking irritates and inflames airways, worsens asthma control, increases attacks, and reduces treatment response; stopping smoking and avoiding secondhand smoke improve outcomes.

Smoking And COPD

Smoking is the major preventable cause of COPD and accelerates lung-function loss; quitting reduces

progression and exacerbations even after COPD is established.

Smoking and Pregnancy

Smoking during pregnancy exposes the fetus to nicotine and other harmful chemicals and increases risks such as poor growth, preterm birth, placental problems, and stillbirth. Stopping at any time is beneficial.

Smoking And Surgery

Smoking before or after an operation increases the risk of breathing problems, wound infection, poor healing, blood clots, heart complications, and failure of repaired tissue. Stopping as early as possible improves recovery, even if surgery is soon.

Smoking Cessation

The process of stopping tobacco or nicotine use. It may involve counseling, behavioral support, medicines, or nicotine replacement.

Smoking Cessation Medications

Medicines that reduce nicotine withdrawal and cravings, including nicotine replacement, bupropion, and varenicline, used with behavioral support and individualized for health risks and preferences.

Smoldering Multiple Myeloma

An asymptomatic plasma-cell disorder with increased clonal plasma cells or monoclonal protein but no myeloma-defining organ damage; it requires risk-based monitoring for progression to active multiple myeloma.

Alternate Names:
Asymptomatic Myeloma; Indolent Myeloma; SMM

Smooth Muscle

Muscle that works automatically in the walls of hollow organs, blood vessels, and airways. It controls processes such as bowel movement, bladder emptying, blood-vessel width, airway narrowing, and childbirth contractions.

Smothering

Mechanical obstruction of the external nose and mouth that prevents effective ventilation. It may be caused by a covering, compression, or an obstructing soft material; findings are often nonspecific and must be interpreted with the scene, history, and complete examination.

Snake Bite

An injury resulting from the penetration of fangs from a venomous or non-venomous snake, which in venomous species introduces complex toxin mixtures into human tissue. Envenomation effects are classified based on venom components into cytotoxins (causing severe tissue necrosis, pain, and compartment syndrome), hemotoxins/coagulotoxins (causing consumption coagulopathy and fatal systemic hemorrhage), and neurotoxins (blocking presynaptic or postsynaptic neuromuscular transmission, causing ptosis, bulbar palsy, and respiratory arrest). Management prioritizes immobilization, monitoring for coagulopathy and compartment syndrome, and prompt administration of species-specific antivenom.

Alternate Names:
Snake Bites; Snake Envenomation

Snake-Bite

A wound from a snake that may cause local injury, envenomation, infection, or systemic toxicity.

Snake Bites

Plural form; see *Snake Bite*.

Snapping Finger

Trigger finger, painful catching or locking of a finger caused by stenosing inflammation around a flexor tendon.

Snapping Hip Syndrome

A clicking or snapping sensation in the hip, sometimes with pain, caused by a tendon moving over bone or by a problem inside the joint. Activity adjustment and exercises often help; persistent pain may need imaging or other treatment.

Sneddon Syndrome

A rare disorder in which small arteries become blocked, causing a net-like purplish skin pattern and repeated strokes or stroke-like events. Headache, high blood pressure, memory problems, or heart-valve changes may also occur.

Sneezing

A forceful reflex expulsion of air through the nose and mouth, often triggered by nasal irritation.

Snellen Chart

A chart of letters or symbols used to measure visual acuity at a specified distance.

Snoring

Noisy breathing during sleep caused by vibration of relaxed or narrowed tissues in the throat. It can be harmless, but loud frequent snoring with pauses in breathing, choking, morning headaches, or daytime sleepiness may indicate sleep apnoea.

Snoring And Sleep Apnea

Snoring is the sound produced by vibrating soft tissues in the upper airway during sleep, often resulting from partial airway obstruction. Sleep apnea is a more serious condition characterized by repeated episodes of complete or partial airway collapse during sleep, leading to intermittent hypoxia, frequent arousal, and fragmented sleep.

Snort

A snort is a forceful nasal or respiratory sound; it may occur with congestion, sleep-disordered breathing, irritation, or inhalation of a substance.

Snot

Alternate informal term; see *Mucus*.

Snow Blindness

A painful temporary burn of the eye's clear front surface caused by intense ultraviolet light, often reflected from snow, ice, water, or sand. Symptoms may include gritty pain, tearing, redness, light sensitivity, and blurred vision.

SNRIs

A class of antidepressants that increase the activity of serotonin and norepinephrine, chemical messengers between nerve cells. They treat depression, some anxiety disorders, and certain nerve or long-lasting pain conditions.

Snuff

Snuff is finely ground tobacco inhaled through the nose or placed in the mouth and can cause nicotine dependence, oral disease, and cardiovascular harm.

Snuffles

A runny or congested nose; in newborns, persistent snuffles can be a sign of congenital syphilis.

Social Anxiety Disorder

Intense, persistent fear of being judged, embarrassed, or rejected in social or performance situations. It can lead to avoidance, physical anxiety symptoms, and difficulty with school, work, relationships, or daily activities.

Social History

Information about a person's living situation, relationships, occupation, education, tobacco or substance use, diet, safety, and other social factors relevant to health and care.

Social Isolation

Limited contact or interaction with other people. Persistent isolation may adversely affect mental and physical health.

Social Media Addiction

Social media addiction is a pattern of difficult-to-control use that causes distress or interferes with sleep, work, school, relationships, or daily activities. It is not a universally defined formal diagnosis.

Social Phobia

Alternate name; see *Social Anxiety Disorder*.

Social Worker

A professional who helps patients and families man-

age practical, emotional, and social problems related to illness. They may arrange community resources, support discharge planning, assist with benefits, and provide counseling or referrals.

Sociophobia

Older term; see *Social Anxiety Disorder*.

Sodium

A mineral and body salt helping control fluid balance, nerves, muscles, and blood pressure; abnormal levels can be harmful.

Sodium Test

A blood test measuring serum sodium, the predominant extracellular cation governing fluid balance and osmotic pressure; see *Sodium* and *Basic Metabolic Panel*.

Sodium Bicarbonate Therapy

Treatment using sodium bicarbonate to make overly acidic blood less acidic in selected conditions, such as some cases of kidney disease. It can increase sodium and fluid load and alter blood potassium or calcium.

Sodium Bisulfate Poisoning

Poisoning from sodium bisulfate, an acidic chemical used in some cleaners and pool products. It can burn the skin, eyes, mouth, and digestive tract; fumes may irritate breathing passages.

Sodium Blood Test

A blood test measuring serum sodium, a major extracellular electrolyte involved in water balance and nerve and muscle function; results are interpreted with fluid status and other electrolytes.

Sodium Carbonate Poisoning

Poisoning from sodium carbonate, an alkaline chemical found in some cleaning products. It may irritate or burn the eyes, skin, mouth, and digestive tract; vomiting can worsen injury after swallowing it.

Sodium Chloride

The salt sodium chloride; sterile solutions are used for fluid replacement, irrigation, and drug dilution.

Sodium Cromoglycate

A mast-cell stabilizer used in selected allergy and asthma treatments; also called cromolyn.

Sodium Diatrizoate

A water-soluble iodinated contrast agent used for selected radiographic examinations. It can cause allergic-like reactions, kidney stress, or aspiration complications, so its use depends on the procedure and patient risks.

Sodium Hydroxide Poisoning

Severe poisoning from sodium hydroxide, a strong alkali in some drain and oven cleaners. It can rapidly burn the mouth, throat, esophagus, stomach, skin, and eyes; vomiting can cause further tissue injury or aspiration.

Sodium Hypochlorite

The active chemical in many bleach and disinfectant products. It kills many germs when used correctly, but concentrated liquid can burn skin, eyes, and the digestive tract; mixing it with acids or ammonia can release dangerous gas.

Sodium Hypochlorite Poisoning

Poisoning from bleach containing sodium hypochlorite. Swallowing may irritate or burn the mouth and digestive tract; mixing bleach with acids or ammonia can release dangerous gases causing cough, chest pain, or breathing failure.

Sodium In Diet

Dietary sodium helps regulate fluid balance and nerve and muscle function, but excess intake can raise blood pressure; processed foods are a major source.

Sodium Polystyrene Sulfonate

A resin that binds potassium in the intestine and has been used to lower high blood potassium. It

can cause constipation and serious intestinal injury.

Sodium-Potassium Pump

A ubiquitous, electrogenic P-type ATPase enzyme complex in eukaryotic plasma membranes that hydrolyzes one molecule of ATP to export three sodium ions from the cell in exchange for importing two potassium ions, maintaining intracellular ion gradients, resting membrane potential, and cellular osmotic volume.

Alternate Names:
Na+/K+-ATPase

Sodium Urine Test

A urine test measuring sodium excretion, used with blood tests and clinical findings to assess volume status, kidney handling of sodium, and causes of hyponatremia or hypertension.

Sodium Valproate

An anticonvulsant and mood stabilizer that carries important pregnancy and reproductive risks, including birth defects and impaired fetal development.

Soft Markers For Aneuploidy

Ultrasound findings during pregnancy that are common in healthy fetuses but occur somewhat more often when there is an extra or missing chromosome. They do not diagnose a chromosome condition and are interpreted with other screening results.

Soft Tissue Augmentation

Restoration or enhancement of volume and contour in skin or underlying soft tissue using fillers, fat transfer, implants, or other reconstructive techniques.

Soft-Tissue Calcinosis

Buildup of calcium deposits in skin, muscles, tendons, or other soft tissues. The deposits may form hard lumps, cause pain or limited movement, break through the skin, or occur because of kidney disease, abnormal calcium levels, inflammation, or tissue damage.

Soft Tissue Injury

Damage to muscles, tendons, ligaments, fascia, skin, or other non-bony tissues, often caused by trauma or overuse.

Soft Tissue Rheumatism

An older broad term for pain or inflammation affecting muscles, tendons, ligaments, or bursae. Modern diagnosis usually names the specific condition, such as tendinitis, bursitis, or a muscle strain.

Soft Tissue Sarcoma

A group of malignant tumors arising in muscle, fat, fibrous tissue, blood vessels, or other connective tissues. Treatment depends on the subtype, location, stage, and relationship to nearby structures.

Alternate Names:
Soft-Tissue Malignancy; Musculoskeletal Sarcoma

Soft Tissue Tumors

Growths arising in muscle, fat, fibrous tissue, blood vessels, nerves, or other supporting tissues. Many are harmless, but some are cancerous; malignant tumors may be deep, enlarging, firm, painful, or persistent.

Soil Contamination

The presence of harmful substances in soil, such as heavy metals, pesticides, fuel, or industrial waste. People may be exposed through food, water, dust, or skin; testing, removal, covering, or treatment of the soil can reduce risk.

Solanine Plant Poisoning

Toxic ingestion of glycoalkaloids (primarily solanine and chaconine) present in high concentrations in green potato tubers, potato sprouts, and green nightshade foliage, causing acute gastrointestinal and neurological symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Potato Glycoalkaloid Toxicity; Green Potato Poisoning; Solanine Intoxication

Solar Elastosis

Solar elastosis is degeneration and thickening of elas-

tic fibers in skin after long-term ultraviolet exposure. It contributes to leathery, wrinkled, yellowish sun-damaged skin.

Solar Keratosis

Alternate name; see *Actinic Keratosis*.

Solar Lentigines

Alternate name; see *Age Spots*.

Solar Plexus

A network of involuntary nerves in the upper abdomen, centered around the celiac plexus. It helps regulate abdominal organs, and irritation or injury may contribute to upper-abdominal pain or altered organ function.

Solar Purpura

Alternate name; see *Actinic Purpura*.

Solar Urticaria

A rare allergic-type reaction to sunlight or other light that causes itchy red raised patches within minutes on exposed skin. The rash usually improves after light exposure ends; widespread reactions can cause systemic symptoms.

Solder Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing solder or inhaling fumes or dust during heating. Products may contain lead, tin, antimony, or other metals and can cause stomach symptoms, anemia, nerve injury, or kidney damage.

Soleus Muscle

A broad muscle beneath the gastrocnemius at the back of the lower leg. It joins the Achilles tendon and helps point the foot downward at the ankle, especially during standing and walking.

Solid Pseudopapillary Pancreatic Tumor

Alternate name; see *Pancreatic Cysts*.

Solitary Fibrous Tumor

A solitary fibrous tumor is a usually slow-growing growth of connective tissue that can arise in the pleura, meninges, or other sites and may rarely behave aggressively.

Solitary Kidney

A solitary kidney means a person has one functioning kidney, because the other kidney is absent, removed, or not working. Many people remain healthy but may need blood-pressure and kidney-function monitoring.

Solitary Pulmonary Nodule

A single small spot in the lung surrounded by otherwise normal lung tissue. It may be a scar, infection, harmless growth, or early cancer; its size, appearance, and change over time determine whether follow-up or biopsy is needed.

Solution

A homogeneous mixture in which one or more substances are dissolved in a solvent; medical solutions include saline and antiseptics.

Solvent Abuse

Harmful inhalation or ingestion of volatile solvents, which can cause neurologic, cardiac, liver, kidney, or respiratory injury.

Solvent Exposure

Contact with organic solvents by inhalation, ingestion, or skin absorption. Acute exposure may cause irritation or central nervous system effects; repeated exposure may damage organs.

Somatic

Relating to the body, especially the body wall and musculoskeletal system, or to physical symptoms.

Somatic Mutation

A genetic change acquired by a body cell during life rather than inherited from a parent. It is passed to descendants of that cell and may contribute to cancer, but it usually is not passed to children.

Somatic Nervous System

The part of the peripheral nervous system that carries sensory information from the skin, muscles, and joints to the central nervous system and controls voluntary movement of skeletal muscles. Its functions also include reflexes that may occur without conscious control.

Somatic Symptom And Related Disorders

A group of mental disorders involving distressing physical symptoms, excessive health-related thoughts or behaviors, illness fears, functional neurologic symptoms, or intentionally produced illness. Examples include somatic symptom disorder, illness anxiety disorder, functional neurologic disorder, and factitious disorder. Malingering is separate because it involves intentional symptom production for an external benefit.

Somatic Symptom Disorder

A mental disorder marked by one or more distressing or life-disrupting physical symptoms and excessive or disproportionate thoughts, feelings, or behaviors related to them or associated health concerns. The symptomatic state is persistent, typically longer than six months; symptoms may be associated with a diagnosed medical condition and need not be medically unexplained.

Somatic Variant

A change in DNA acquired by a body cell after conception rather than inherited from a parent. It usually cannot be passed to children but may affect only some tissues or contribute to cancer.

Somatization

The experience or expression of psychological distress through physical symptoms such as pain, fatigue, or stomach problems. The symptoms are real and not intentional and may coexist with physical disease.

Somatostatin

A hormone made in the brain, pancreas, and digestive tract that slows growth hormone, insulin, glucagon, and digestive-hormone release. It also reduces movement and secretion within parts of the digestive system.

Somatostatin Analog

A medicine that imitates somatostatin, a hormone that slows the release of several hormones and digestive secretions. It is used for selected hormone-producing tumors, acromegaly, severe diarrhea, and some bleeding conditions.

Somatostatinoma

A rare hormone-producing tumor usually arising in the pancreas or small intestine. It may cause diabetes, diarrhea or greasy stools, gallstones, weight loss, or no symptoms; treatment depends on whether it has spread and may include surgery or cancer medicines.

Somatotropic Pituitary Adenoma

A usually noncancerous pituitary tumor that makes too much growth hormone. In adults it causes acromegaly, with enlargement of the hands, feet, jaw, or other tissues; in children it can cause excessive height before growth ends.

Somatotropin

Growth hormone, produced by the pituitary gland. It supports childhood growth and influences protein, fat, and carbohydrate metabolism; excess or deficiency can cause characteristic growth and metabolic disorders.

Somatotype

A descriptive body-build classification; it is not a disease diagnosis.

Somnambulism

Sleepwalking or performing other activities while only partly awake, usually during deep sleep. Episodes are more common in children and may be triggered by lack of sleep, stress, illness, or medicines; safety measures are important, especially if wandering or injury occurs.

Somniloquy

Talking, laughing, or making sounds during sleep without knowing it. It is usually harmless, but frequent or disruptive episodes may occur with sleepwalking, nightmares, breathing problems during sleep, medicines, or other sleep disorders.

Alternate Names:
Nocturnal Vocalization; Sleep Utterance; Parasomnia Vocalization

Somnolence

Unusual sleepiness or a tendency to fall asleep when a person should be awake. It may result from too little sleep, medicines, alcohol or drugs, sleep disorders, metabolic illness, or neurologic disease.

Somnolent

Somnolent means unusually sleepy or drowsy, which may result from sleep deprivation, medicines, intoxication, metabolic illness, or neurologic disease.

Somogyi Effect

A proposed pattern of early-morning high blood glucose following unrecognized overnight hypoglycemia in a person using insulin. Counterregulatory hormones raise glucose after the low; it is distinguished from the dawn phenomenon by documented overnight hypoglycemia.

Alternate Names:
Somogyi Phenomenon; Rebound Hyperglycemia

Somogyi Phenomenon

A proposed pattern of morning hyperglycemia following unrecognized overnight hypoglycemia, with counterregulatory hormone release. Continuous or overnight glucose measurements are needed to distinguish it from the more common dawn phenomenon before changing therapy.

Sonographer

A healthcare professional trained to obtain diagnostic ultrasound images. They position the patient, operate the scanner, record appropriate views and measurements, and document findings for interpretation by a qualified clinician.

Sonohysterography

Sonohysterography is an ultrasound examination in which sterile fluid is placed in the uterus to outline the uterine cavity and assess problems such as polyps or fibroids.

Soporifics

Medicines or substances that cause sleepiness or promote sleep. They may impair alertness, coordination, and breathing, especially when combined with alcohol or other sedatives.

Sorbitol

A sugar alcohol used as a sweetener and in some medicines. Larger amounts draw water into the bowel and act as a laxative, but may cause gas, cramps, diarrhea, or dehydration.

Sore

Painful or tender, or describing an open area on skin or a moist body lining. A sore may result from injury, infection, inflammation, pressure, allergy, or another medical condition.

Sore Throat

Pain, scratchiness, or irritation in the throat. Common causes include viral infections, bacterial infections, allergies, dry air, smoke, voice strain, and acid reflux; drooling, inability to swallow, a muffled voice, neck swelling, or breathing difficulty can signal airway or deep-throat complications.

Sotalol

A beta-blocking, class III antiarrhythmic medicine used for selected cardiac rhythm disorders. It prolongs cardiac repolarization and the QT interval; excessive prolongation can trigger torsades de pointes, a potentially fatal ventricular arrhythmia. Reduced kidney function can increase drug exposure and risk.

Sotos Syndrome

A genetic disorder that causes unusually rapid growth in childhood, a large head, distinctive facial features, and delayed development or learning difficulties. Coordination, behavior, seizures, heart problems, or kidney problems may also occur.

Growth usually slows with age. A change in the *NSD1* gene causes most cases.

Alternate Names:
Cerebral Gigantism; NSD1-Related Overgrowth Syndrome

Sound

Mechanical energy transmitted as waves and perceived by hearing; clinical sound assessment includes speech and respiratory or cardiac sounds.

Source Control

A procedure or intervention that eliminates, drains, debrides, or otherwise controls an anatomic focus of infection or contamination. Examples include drainage of an abscess, removal of infected tissue or device, and repair of a perforation.

Soy

Soy is a legume providing protein and isoflavones; it is nutritious for many people but can cause allergy and may interact with some medicines or thyroid treatment timing.

Soya

Soybean and products made from it; soy is a food source and can cause allergy in susceptible people.

Soybeans

Soybeans are legumes that provide protein, fiber, and compounds called isoflavones. They are used in foods such as tofu and soy milk; allergy is possible.

Soy Protein Intolerance

Adverse gastrointestinal reaction to soy proteins, most often seen in infants and young children. It may cause vomiting, diarrhoea, abdominal pain, blood or mucus in the stool, feeding difficulty, or poor growth.

Space Medicine

The medical specialty concerned with human health and performance during aviation and space travel. It addresses altered gravity, radiation, isolation, motion sickness, sleep, emergencies, exercise, and returning safely to Earth.

Spacer

A chamber attached to a metered-dose inhaler that holds the released medicine briefly, making it easier to breathe into the lungs and reducing medicine left in the mouth or throat.

Alternate Names:
Valved Holding Chamber; Aerosol Spacer

Spanish Fly

A historical name for cantharidin-containing blister beetles; ingestion is poisonous and it is not a safe aphrodisiac.

Sparganosis

A rare tissue infection caused by the larval stage of *Spirometra* tapeworms. People may become infected by drinking water containing infected tiny crustaceans, eating raw or undercooked infected animals such as frogs or snakes, or applying infected animal tissue to the skin or eye. The larvae can form lumps under the skin or affect the eye, brain, or other organs.

Spasm

An involuntary, often painful tightening of one muscle or a group of muscles. Spasms may result from fatigue, dehydration, nerve disease, injury, medicines, inflammation, or problems affecting the brain or spinal cord.

Spasmodic Dysphonia

Spasmodic dysphonia is a focal laryngeal dystonia causing involuntary voice-box spasms and strained, breathy, or interrupted speech.

Spasmodic Torticollis

A form of neck dystonia with involuntary muscle contractions causing twisting, tilting, or abnormal neck posture.

Spasmus Nutans

An uncommon early-childhood syndrome of rapid shimmering eye movements, head nodding, and tor-

ticollis that usually resolves; similar signs can occur with neurologic or ocular disease.

Spastic

Describes muscles that are unusually tight and resist being stretched, especially when moved quickly. It may cause stiffness, jerking, abnormal posture, and difficulty controlling movement after nervous-system injury.

Spastic Colon

Alternate name; see *Irritable Bowel Syndrome*.

Spastic Diplegia

A clinical subtype of cerebral palsy historically associated with prematurity and periventricular leukomalacia, characterized by symmetrical spastic hypertonia affecting the lower extremities significantly more than the upper extremities, producing a characteristic "scissor gait" with hip adduction and internal rotation.

Spastic Dysphonia

A voice disorder caused by involuntary spasms of the muscles used for speaking, also called spasmodic dysphonia. The voice may sound strained, broken, breathy, or weak; assessment distinguishes it from structural and neurologic causes.

Spastic Gait

An abnormal walking pattern characterized by stiff, dragging legs, internal rotation of the foot, plantar flexion, and a semicircular circumduction movement of the affected lower limb during the swing phase. It is caused by unilateral or bilateral corticospinal tract (upper motor neuron) damage, such as in cerebral palsy, stroke, or multiple sclerosis.

Spasticity

Velocity-dependent increase in muscle tone caused by an upper motor-neuron lesion, producing stiffness, spasms, abnormal reflexes, and restricted movement.

Spatial Resolution

The ability of an imaging system to show two nearby small objects as separate. Better resolution shows finer detail, but the result depends on the scanner, movement, body part, scan settings, and the type of imaging used.

Speaking with a Tracheostomy Tube

Speech with a tracheostomy tube may be supported by cuff deflation, a speaking valve, or other methods when airflow and airway protection are adequate; specialist assessment is required.

Special Care Baby Unit

A ward within a hospital that provides specialist care for newborn babies who need additional support but not intensive care.

Special Stain

A histochemical stain that highlights a particular tissue component, organism, or deposited substance not adequately demonstrated by routine hematoxylin and eosin. Examples include periodic acid-Schiff, Ziehl-Neelsen, Congo red, and Gomori methenamine silver stains.

Specific Absorbed Fraction

The portion of energy released by radiation in one body area that is absorbed by a particular organ or tissue. It helps calculate the radiation dose during nuclear-medicine treatment or testing.

Specific Activity

The amount of radioactivity in a given amount of material. It matters when preparing radioactive medicines because enough activity is needed for imaging or treatment while limiting the amount of substance and unnecessary exposure.

Specific Gravity

A comparison of urine density with water that gives an estimate of how concentrated the urine is. It may rise with dehydration, sugar, or protein in urine and fall when the kidneys cannot concentrate urine or when excess fluid is present.

Specificity

A test's ability to correctly identify people who do not have the condition being tested.

Specific Learning Disorder

A developmental condition causing lasting difficulty learning or using reading, writing, or mathematics skills despite appropriate teaching. The difficulty interferes with school, work, or daily activities and is not explained only by poor instruction, vision, hearing, or intellectual disability.

Specific Phobia

A disorder involving marked, persistent fear or anxiety about a particular object or situation. The fear is excessive relative to the actual danger, leads to avoidance or intense distress, and interferes with daily functioning.

Specific Reading Disability

Alternate name; see *Dyslexia*.

Specimen Adequacy

The degree to which a collected clinical specimen is sufficient in quantity, correctly identified, properly transported, and representative of the site being tested. Inadequacy can cause invalid, misleading, or falsely negative results.

Specimen Container

A clean, suitable container used to collect, identify, protect, and transport a patient sample for laboratory testing. Container type, labeling, closure, and handling depend on the sample and test.

Specimen Transport Medium

A special liquid or gel that keeps germs or cells suitable for testing while a patient sample travels to the laboratory. The medium, temperature, container, and delivery time depend on the sample and suspected infection.

Speckled Lentiginous Nevus (Nevus Spilus)

A flat tan or brown patch containing multiple darker macules or papules. It is usually benign, although melanoma can rarely arise within a melanocytic nevus, including an atypical component.

SPECT/CT

A combined scan that uses a radioactive tracer to show organ function and CT to show detailed body structure. The two sets of images are matched to help locate abnormal areas.

Alternate Names:
Single-Photon Emission Computed Tomography/Computed Tomography; SPECT-CT

Spectral Analysis

Examination of the different energy levels within radiation or another signal. In medical imaging, it can separate useful information from background scatter and help identify materials or improve image interpretation.

SPECT Scan

A nuclear-medicine scan that uses a small radioactive tracer and a rotating camera to create three-dimensional pictures of blood flow or organ function. It can examine the heart, brain, bones, kidneys, or other organs.

Alternate Names:
SPECT Imaging; Single-Photon Emission Tomography

Speculum

An instrument used to gently separate or hold open the walls of a body passage so that the area can be visualized, examined, sampled, or treated. Common types include vaginal, nasal, ear, and rectal specula; design and size depend on the body site and intended procedure.

Speech

The production of spoken language using breathing, voice, and movements of the tongue, lips, palate, and other structures. Hearing, brain function, teeth, illness, and dental appliances can affect speech.

Speech And Language Delay

Slower-than-expected development of speech sounds, vocabulary, understanding, or use of language in a child. Causes may include hearing loss, developmental disorders, autism, neurologic disease, or other medical and environmental factors.

Speech Audiometry

Hearing testing that measures detection or recognition of speech at different loudness levels. It commonly includes speech reception threshold and word-recognition testing, complementing pure-tone audiometry.

Alternate Names:
Speech Discrimination Testing; Speech Audiometric Evaluation

Speech Delay

Speech or language development that is slower than expected for a child's age. Causes may include hearing loss, developmental differences, autism, neurologic disease, or limited language access; loss of previously learned skills can indicate developmental regression.

Speech Discrimination

A hearing test that measures how well a person understands spoken words at a comfortable loudness. The result helps assess hearing function beyond the ability to detect pure tones.

Speech Disorders

Conditions that affect making speech sounds, speaking smoothly, using the voice, or controlling the movements needed for speech. They may follow hearing loss, developmental differences, brain injury, stroke, nerve disease, or other conditions and can often be assessed by a speech therapist.

Speech Impairment In Adults

Difficulty producing or understanding speech caused by aphasia, dysarthria, apraxia, hearing loss, neurologic disease, structural problems, or cognitive disorder; sudden onset requires stroke assessment.

Speech Sound Disorder

A developmental communication disorder involving persistent difficulty with the motor production, articulation, or phonological representation of speech sounds; see *Articulation Disorder*.

Speech-Language Pathologist

A clinician who evaluates and treats disorders of speech, language, voice, communication, cognition, and swallowing across childhood, adulthood, and older age.

Speech-Language Pathology Assessment

An evaluation of speech, language, voice, communication, swallowing, and sometimes related cognitive skills. It combines interview, clinical observation, and standardized or functional tests to guide therapy.

Speech Therapy

Assessment and treatment to help with speaking, understanding language, voice, communication, or swallowing. A speech and language therapist may use exercises, practice, communication aids, and advice for the person and family.

Sperm

Mature male gametes produced in the testes. Each normally carries 23 chromosomes and has a head containing genetic material, a midpiece that supplies energy, and a tail that helps it move; semen contains sperm plus fluids from reproductive glands.

Spermarche

The onset of sperm production and the first ejaculation, marking an important stage of male puberty.

Spermatic

Relating to sperm or structures that produce, transport, or support sperm. Spermatic structures include the testes, ducts, blood vessels, nerves, and tissues involved in male reproductive function.

Spermatic Cord

A cord-like structure carrying the vas deferens, tes-

ticular blood vessels, nerves, lymph vessels, and supporting tissue. It extends through the groin to the testis and may be affected by hernia, twisting, or infection.

Spermatocele

A usually harmless, fluid-filled cyst beside or within the epididymis, the coiled tube behind the testicle. It often causes no symptoms but may feel like a lump or cause discomfort.

Spermatocele (Epididymal Cyst)

A usually benign, fluid-filled cyst arising in the epididymis near the testicle. It may cause a painless scrotal lump or heaviness and is distinguished from tumors, hydrocele, infection, and other causes by examination and ultrasound.

Spermatogenesis

The production and maturation of sperm in the seminiferous tubules of the testes. It depends on germ cells, Sertoli cells, hormones, and suitable testicular temperature.

Spermatogonium

An early male reproductive cell in the testis that divides and develops into primary spermatocytes, beginning sperm production.

Spermatorrhea

Involuntary leakage or discharge of semen, sometimes occurring during sleep or without orgasm. Occasional nocturnal emissions can be normal; persistent discharge, pain, blood, or urinary symptoms may reflect infection or another genital or urinary condition.

Spermatozoa

Mature male reproductive cells, also called sperm. Each normally carries half the usual chromosome number and has a head, middle section, and tail that helps it move toward an egg.

Spermatozoon

A single mature male reproductive cell, or sperm cell. The singular form of spermatozoa: one mature male reproductive cell capable of carrying genetic material to an egg.

Sperm Cell

Alternate name; see *Sperm*.

Spermicide

A contraceptive substance that kills or immobilizes sperm, often used with condoms or other barrier methods.

Sperm Retrieval

A procedure that obtains sperm from semen, the epididymis, or testicular tissue for fertility treatment or laboratory testing. The method depends on whether sperm are present in the semen and on the cause of infertility.

Alternate Names:
Sperm Extraction; Surgical Sperm Recovery

S Phase

The stage of the cell cycle when a cell copies all of its DNA before dividing. This duplication allows each new cell to receive a complete set of genetic instructions.

Sphenoid

Relating to the sphenoid bone, a central bone at the base of the skull. It helps form the eye sockets and skull base and contains the hollow spaces called the sphenoid sinuses.

Sphenoidal Sinus

A paired air-filled sinus within the sphenoid bone at the base of the skull. It lies near important nerves and blood vessels, so inflammation or surgery in this area can affect vision, sensation, or nearby blood flow.

Sphenoid Bone

A central bone at the base of the skull that helps form the eye sockets and skull base. It contains the sphenoid sinuses and a hollow that holds the pituitary gland.

Sphenoid Sinusitis

Inflammation or infection of the sphenoid sinus, which lies deep behind the nasal cavity. It may cause deep headache, facial pain, or visual symptoms and can rarely spread to nearby nerves or the brain.

Spherocytes

Red blood cells that are unusually round and dense instead of having their normal flattened shape. They may occur when the cell membrane is damaged or removed, especially in hereditary spherocytosis or immune red-cell destruction.

Spherocytic Anemia

Anemia caused by fragile, sphere-shaped red blood cells that are removed early by the spleen. It is often inherited as hereditary spherocytosis and may cause jaundice, gallstones, fatigue, or an enlarged spleen.

Sphincter

A ring-shaped muscle that opens and closes a body passage. Sphincters help control urine, stool, food, bile, and other fluids; examples include the muscles around the anus, bladder outlet, and stomach outlet.

Sphincter Of Oddi

A muscular valve controlling the release of bile and pancreatic juice into the first part of the small intestine. It opens during digestion and abnormal blockage or tightening can cause pain or pancreatitis.

Sphingomyelinase Deficiency

Deficiency of acid sphingomyelinase caused by variants in the *SMPD1* gene. It causes Niemann-Pick disease types A, A/B, or B, with lipid accumulation affecting the spleen, liver, lungs, brain, or other organs.

Sphygmograph

An instrument or sensor that records the shape and timing of the pulse in an artery. The tracing can provide information about circulation and arterial stiffness.

Sphygmomanometer

A device used to measure arterial blood pressure with an inflatable cuff and pressure-measuring system. Manual versions commonly use an aneroid or mercury manometer with a stethoscope, while electronic versions use sensors to analyze pressure oscillations and display the reading.

Alternate Names:
Blood Pressure Gauge

Spider Angioma

Alternate name; see *Spider Naevi*.

Spider Bite

An injury caused by the fangs (chelicerae) of a spider, with the vast majority causing only minor local erythematous reactions. Medically significant bites in North America stem from the black widow (*Latrodectus*), which injects alpha-latrotoxin (causing massive presynaptic acetylcholine and catecholamine release, producing severe abdominal rigidity, muscle cramping, autonomic instability, and latrodectism), and the brown recluse (*Loxosceles*), which injects sphingomyelinase D (causing localized ischemic necrosis, eschar formation, and loxoscelism with occasional severe intravascular hemolysis).

Alternate Names:
Spider Bites; Arachnidism

Spider Bites

Plural form; see *Spider Bite*.

Spider Naevi

Vascular cutaneous lesions characterized by a central, pulsating red arteriole from which fine, radiating telangiectatic capillaries branch outward like spider legs. Digital pressure blanches the lesion, and upon release it refills rapidly from the center outwards; multiple spider naevi in the superior vena cava distribution (face, neck, upper chest) are classic physical signs of hyperestrogenic states in chronic liver disease, cirrhosis, and pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Spider Angioma; Spider Naevus; Spider Telangiectasia; Nevus Araneus; Vascular Spider

Spider Naevus

Alternate name; see *Spider Naevi*.

Spider Telangiectasia

Alternate name; see *Spider Naevi*.

Spider Veins

Small visible red, blue, or purple superficial veins, usually on the legs or face. They are generally harmless but may occur with venous insufficiency; sudden pain, swelling, skin ulceration, or one-sided change can signal another vascular problem.

Spielmeyer-Vogt-Batten Syndrome

Alternate historical name for juvenile neuronal ceroid lipofuscinosis, commonly called Batten disease. It usually begins in childhood with vision loss followed by seizures, developmental regression, movement problems, and dementia.

Spielmeyer-Vogt Disease

An older name for neuronal ceroid lipofuscinosis, a group of inherited lysosomal disorders causing progressive loss of vision, seizures, movement problems, and cognitive decline.

Spigelian Hernia

A ventral abdominal wall hernia protruding through a defect in the Spigelian aponeurosis along the semilunar line (between the lateral border of the rectus abdominis muscle and the transversus abdominis aponeurosis), most frequently located below the arcuate line.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Ventral Hernia; Spigelian Aponeurosis Hernia

Spina Bifida

A congenital spinal defect in which one or more vertebral arches do not form or close completely. In open forms, the meninges, spinal cord, or both protrude through the defect; spina bifida occulta may involve only a skin-covered vertebral gap. Neurologic effects vary by type and level and may include leg weakness or problems with bladder and bowel control.

Spina Bifida Meningocele

Alternate name for the spinal form of meningocele; see *Meningocele*.

Spina Bifida Myelomeningocele

Alternate name; see *Myelomeningocele*.

Spina Bifida Occulta

A usually mild congenital defect in which the posterior parts of one or more vertebrae fail to fuse, while the overlying skin remains intact; the spinal cord and meninges do not protrude through the bony gap. Most people have no symptoms, and the finding is often discovered incidentally on imaging. A dimple, patch of hair, or other skin mark may overlie the defect. Rarely, associated tethering or another spinal dysraphism causes pain, weakness, sensory changes, or bladder or bowel problems.

Spinal Analgesia

Pain relief produced by injecting numbing medicine, sometimes with an opioid, into the fluid around the lower spinal nerves. It may cause temporary leg weakness, itching, difficulty urinating, low blood pressure, headache, or slowed breathing.

Spinal And Bulbar Muscular Atrophy

An X-linked disorder caused by a CAG-repeat expansion in the androgen-receptor gene. It usually affects adult men and gradually damages motor neurons, causing muscle weakness and wasting, cramps, twitching, difficulty speaking or swallowing, and sometimes breast enlargement or reduced fertility. Treatment supports movement, swallowing, breathing, and daily activities.

Alternate Names:
X-Linked Spinal and Bulbar Muscular Atrophy; Kennedy Disease; Kennedy's Disease; SBMA

Alternate Names:
Kennedy Disease; SBMA

Spinal And Epidural Anesthesia

Spinal and epidural anesthesia deliver local anes-

thetic near spinal nerves to numb the lower body; spinal is a single injection, while epidural uses a catheter for adjustable dosing.

Spinal Anesthesia

An injection of numbing medicine into the fluid around the lower spinal nerves to temporarily block pain and movement in the lower body. Possible effects include low blood pressure, difficulty urinating, headache, infection, bleeding, or rarely excessive numbness and breathing problems.

Alternate Names:
Subarachnoid Block; Spinal Block

Spinal Anesthesia For Cesarean Delivery

A regional anesthetic injected into the fluid around the lower spinal nerves to numb the lower body during a cesarean birth. The mother remains awake, while blood pressure, breathing, and the baby's condition are monitored.

Spinal Angiography

X-ray imaging of blood vessels supplying the spinal cord after contrast is injected. It is used to locate vascular malformations, fistulas, aneurysms, or sources of bleeding and may guide treatment.

Spinal Arachnoiditis

Chronic inflammation and scarring of the arachnoid membrane around spinal nerves. It may cause persistent burning pain, tingling, weakness, or bowel and bladder problems after infection, surgery, trauma, bleeding, or chemical irritation.

Spinal Artery

An artery supplying the spinal cord and its coverings, including the anterior spinal artery and paired posterior spinal arteries; blockage can cause characteristic neurologic deficits.

Spinal Block

A spinal block is injection of local anesthetic into cerebrospinal fluid in the lower back, producing temporary numbness and weakness for surgery or pain control.

Spinal Canal

The spinal canal is the bony passage through the vertebral column containing the spinal cord, its coverings, nerve roots, and blood vessels.

Spinal Cavity

The posterior body cavity formed by the vertebral column that contains and protects the spinal cord.

Spinal Chordoma

A malignant notochord-derived tumor arising along the spine, often in the sacrum. It can produce progressive pain, a mass, weakness, numbness, or bowel and bladder dysfunction and requires specialist imaging and treatment.

Spinal Column

The vertebral column, consisting of vertebrae, discs, ligaments, and joints that support and protect the spinal cord.

Spinal Cord

The cylindrical nervous tissue within the vertebral canal that carries signals between brain and body and mediates reflexes.

Spinal Cord Abscess

A rare collection of pus within the spinal cord, usually caused by infection. It can damage or compress nerve tissue and cause back pain, fever, weakness, sensory changes, or bladder problems. An epidural abscess is a separate infection outside the spinal cord.

Spinal Cord and Spine Disorders

Diseases or injuries affecting the spinal bones, discs, ligaments, spinal cord, or nerve roots. They may cause pain, weakness, numbness, balance problems, deformity, or changes in bladder and bowel function.

Spinal Cord Cleft

A cleft-like division or indentation within the spinal cord, described on imaging or during surgery. It may occur as part of a congenital split-cord malformation or as a focal acquired abnormality associated with

nearby spinal or dural pathology.

Spinal Cord Compression

Pressure on the spinal cord or its nerve roots, often from a tumor, infection, bleeding, fracture, or slipped disc. It can cause severe back pain, weakness, numbness, walking difficulty, or loss of bladder or bowel control.

Spinal Cord Disease

A disorder affecting the spinal cord, including compression, inflammation, vascular injury, infection, tumor, degeneration, or trauma, and potentially causing weakness, sensory loss, or autonomic dysfunction.

Spinal Cord Hemisection

Damage affecting one side of the spinal cord. Depending on its extent, it can cause weakness and loss of limb-position sense on the same side of the body, and loss of pain and temperature sense on the opposite side. The classic pattern is called Brown-Sequard syndrome.

Spinal Cord Infarction

Injury to the spinal cord caused by interruption of its blood supply, often involving the anterior spinal artery or aortic circulation. It typically produces sudden back or limb pain followed by weakness, sensory loss, and bladder or bowel dysfunction.

Spinal Cord Injuries

Traumatic damage to the spinal cord that can cause temporary or permanent motor, sensory, autonomic, respiratory, or bowel and bladder dysfunction. Severity depends on the level and completeness of injury.

Spinal Cord Injury

Damage to the spinal cord that can cause weakness, paralysis, altered sensation, or loss of bladder and bowel control. Severity is often graded from complete to incomplete using a standardized neurological examination.

Alternate Names:
SCI

Spinal Cord Injury: Treatments And Rehabilitation

Spinal-cord injury can cause temporary or permanent weakness, sensory loss, autonomic dysfunction, and bowel or bladder problems. Acute care protects the spine and treats complications; rehabilitation addresses mobility, skin, breathing, function, equipment, sexuality, and community participation.

Spinal Cord Neoplasms

Tumors arising in the spinal cord, its coverings, or nearby tissues. They may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause pain, weakness, numbness, walking problems, or bladder and bowel changes by pressing on nerves.

Spinal Cord Stimulation

An implanted treatment that delivers electrical impulses to the epidural space to alter pain signaling, used for selected chronic neuropathic or ischemic pain after careful assessment.

Spinal Cord Trauma

Spinal cord trauma is injury to the cord from force such as fracture, dislocation, or penetrating damage, potentially causing weakness, sensory loss, autonomic dysfunction, or paralysis.

Spinal Curvature

A curve or bend in the spine. The term may refer to normal curves or abnormal curvature, including scoliosis, kyphosis, or lordosis.

Spinal Disease

Any disorder affecting the vertebrae, discs, joints, ligaments, spinal cord, or nerve roots. It may cause back or neck pain, stiffness, weakness, numbness, walking difficulty, or changes in bladder or bowel control.

Spinal Dysraphism

A group of birth defects caused by incomplete development or closure of the spine and spinal cord before birth. Some forms have an open sac on the back, while others are hidden and may later cause weakness, pain, or bladder and bowel problems.

Spinal Epidural Abscess

A collection of pus between the covering of the spinal cord and the surrounding bone, usually caused by infection. Severe back pain, fever, weakness, numbness, difficulty walking, or loss of bladder or bowel control may occur.

Spinal Epidural Hematoma

A collection of blood in the space between the spinal cord's outer covering and the bones of the spine. It can press on the spinal cord or nerves and cause sudden severe pain, weakness, numbness, or loss of bladder or bowel control.

Spinal Arachnoid Cyst

A fluid-filled sac in or near the arachnoid, one of the thin coverings around the spinal cord. Many cause no symptoms. A cyst that presses on the cord or nerve roots can cause back pain, weakness, numbness, or problems with walking or bladder control.

Spinal Astrocytoma

A tumor that begins in astrocytes, support cells in the brain or spinal cord. In the spine, it often grows within the spinal cord and may cause pain, weakness, numbness, or difficulty walking. Its behavior varies by tumor type and grade.

Spinal Ependymoma

A tumor that begins in cells lining the central canal of the spinal cord. It can grow within the cord or along its surface and may cause back pain, weakness, numbness, or changes in walking or bladder function. Its behavior depends on its type and grade.

Spinal Instability

Abnormal movement between spinal bones that reduces the spine's ability to keep its usual alignment and protect nearby nerves. It may result from injury, wear, infection, or surgery and can cause pain or, if nerves are affected, weakness or numbness.

Spinal Meningioma

A usually slow-growing tumor that begins in the thin coverings around the spinal cord. Most spinal meningiomas are noncancerous, but a growing tumor can press on the cord or nerves and cause pain, weakness, numbness, or difficulty walking. Symptoms depend on the tumor's size and location.

Spinal Osteoarthritis

Wear of the cartilage in the small joints between spinal bones, most often the facet joints. It may cause back or neck pain and stiffness, especially with movement. Bone spurs can form and sometimes narrow the spaces for spinal nerves.

Spinal Osteoporosis

Loss of bone strength in the vertebrae, the bones of the spine. Weakened vertebrae can break or collapse during a minor fall or ordinary activity, causing back pain, loss of height, or a rounded upper back. Bone loss may remain silent until a fracture occurs. See also *Osteoporosis*.

Spinal Schwannoma

A usually noncancerous tumor that grows from Schwann cells, which wrap around nerves. It often begins on a nerve root near the spinal cord and may cause pain, tingling, numbness, or weakness if it presses on the nerve. Most spinal schwannomas grow slowly.

Spinal Tuberculosis (Pott Disease)

Alternate name; see *Pott Disease*.

Spinal Fluid Leak

Alternate name; see *Cerebrospinal Fluid Leak*.

Spinal Fracture

A fracture of one or more vertebrae caused by trauma, osteoporosis, tumor, or other bone-weakening disease.

Spinal Fusion

Surgery that joins two or more spinal bones so they heal into one stable segment. Bone and often screws, rods, or cages are used; the operation may reduce movement and pain from selected conditions but can cause infection, nerve injury, or problems at

nearby levels.

Spinal Ganglion

A small group of nerve-cell bodies beside the spinal cord. It contains sensory nerve cells that carry information about touch, pain, temperature, and body position from the skin, muscles, and joints.

Spinal Injury

Damage to the spinal cord, vertebrae, discs, ligaments, or nearby nerves caused by trauma or another disease. It may cause pain, weakness, numbness, paralysis, or bladder and bowel problems and can be life-threatening when severe.

Spinal Meningitis

Inflammation or infection of the membranes surrounding the spinal cord, often occurring with meningitis involving the brain. Fever, severe headache, neck or back stiffness, confusion, rash, or neurologic changes may occur.

Spinal Metastasis

Spread of a cancer to the vertebrae, spinal canal, or nearby epidural tissues. Back pain, weakness, numbness, gait change, or bowel or bladder dysfunction may signal spinal cord or nerve compression.

Spinal Muscular Atrophy

Usually an autosomal recessive inherited disorder causing progressive loss of motor neurons and muscle weakness, often beginning in infancy or childhood but sometimes appearing in adulthood. Severity varies; breathing, swallowing, and mobility may be affected. Early diagnosis allows genetic counseling and disease-modifying care.

Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA)

Alternate name; see *Spinal Muscular Atrophy*.

Spinal Neoplasms

Tumors arising in the spinal cord, its coverings, vertebrae, or nearby tissues. They may be noncancerous or cancerous and can cause back pain, weakness, numbness, walking difficulty, or bladder and bowel changes when they press on nerves.

Spinal Nerve

One of 31 pairs of nerves leaving the spinal cord through openings between the spinal bones. Each carries messages for sensation, movement, and automatic functions between the body and spinal cord.

Spinal Precautions

Measures used after possible spinal injury to limit movement until the spine and spinal cord have been assessed. They may include careful positioning, support of the neck, and safe transfer; the exact approach depends on the injury and examination.

Spinal Reflex

A fast, automatic response that is processed through the spinal cord. It can occur before the brain becomes aware of the stimulus.

Spinal Shock

A temporary loss of reflexes, muscle tone, and automatic functions below a spinal-cord injury. The affected limbs may initially be limp, and blood-pressure, bladder, bowel, or sexual problems can occur while the injury is assessed and treated.

Spinal Stenosis

Narrowing of the passage containing the spinal cord or nerve roots. It may cause back pain, numbness, weakness, or leg pain with walking that improves when sitting or leaning forward.

Alternate Names:
Vertebral Canal Stenosis; Lumbar Spinal Narrowing

Spinal Stenosis Lumbar

Alternate name; see *Lumbar Stenosis*.

Spinal Tap

Alternate name; see *Lumbar Puncture*.

Spinal Tuberculosis

Alternate name; see *Pott's Disease*.

Spinal Tumor

A benign or malignant neoplasm located within or adjacent to the spinal cord, spinal nerve roots, meninges, or vertebral column. Categorized anatomically into extradural tumors (most commonly metastatic carcinoma from breast, lung, prostate, or myeloma), intradural-extramedullary tumors (predominantly meningiomas and schwannomas), and intramedullary tumors (primarily ependymomas and astrocytomas). Manifestations reflect spinal cord compression, radiculopathy, progressive motor and sensory deficits, and autonomic dysfunction; urgent MRI with gadolinium and surgical decompression with radiation/chemotherapy are essential to preserve neurological function.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Tumors; Spinal Neoplasm; Spinal Neoplasms

Spinal Tumors

Plural form; see *Spinal Tumor*.

Spindle-Cell Sarcoma

A group of cancers made of long, narrow cells under the microscope. They can arise from muscle, fibrous tissue, or nerve coverings; their behavior and treatment vary by the exact tumor type and location.

Spindle Pole

One end of the temporary structure formed during cell division. Fibers extending from each pole attach to duplicated chromosomes and pull the copies into the two new cells.

Spindle Pole Body

A structure in fungal cells that organizes the fibers used to separate duplicated chromosomes during cell division. It performs a role similar to the centrosome in animal cells.

Spine

The vertebral column, consisting of stacked vertebrae that support the body and protect the spinal cord.

Spine Disorders

Conditions affecting the bones, disks, joints, ligaments, nerves, or spinal cord. They may cause back or neck pain, stiffness, weakness, numbness, balance problems, or changes in bladder and bowel control.

Spine Injury

Damage to the bones, discs, ligaments, nerves, or spinal cord. It may cause back pain, weakness, numbness, loss of movement, or bladder and bowel problems; spinal-cord damage can cause permanent disability.

Spinocerebellar Ataxia

A heterogeneous group of progressive, autosomal dominant neurodegenerative disorders characterized by progressive cerebellar ataxia, dysmetria, dysarthria, nystagmus, and oculomotor dysfunction, often accompanied by peripheral neuropathy, pyramidal or extrapyramidal signs, or cognitive decline. Many subtypes (e.g., SCA1, SCA2, SCA3/Machado-Joseph disease, SCA6, SCA7) are caused by unstable trinucleotide (CAG) repeat expansions encoding polyglutamine tracts that lead to toxic protein aggregation and Purkinje cell loss in the cerebellum and brainstem.

Alternate Names:
Spinocerebellar Ataxias; SCA

Spinocerebellar Ataxias

Plural form; see *Spinocerebellar Ataxia*.

Spinothalamic Tract

The primary ascending somatic sensory pathway conveying pain, thermal sensation, and crude non-discriminative touch from peripheral free nerve endings through the spinal cord (decussating within 1 to 2 segments in the anterior white commissure) to the ventral posterolateral (VPL) nucleus of the thalamus.

Spinous Process

The backward-pointing bony projection of a vertebra that can be felt along the middle of the back. Muscles and ligaments attach to it and help support and move the spine.

Spiradenocarcinoma

A rare malignant sweat-gland tumor that may arise in a long-standing spiradenoma, presenting as a rapidly enlarging, painful, or ulcerated nodule.

Spiradenoma

A usually benign painful sweat-gland tumor presenting as a dermal nodule; multiple spiradenomas may occur in Brooke-Spiegler syndrome.

Spiral Organ

The organ of Corti, a sensory structure in the cochlea containing hair cells that convert sound vibrations into nerve signals.

Spiramycin

A macrolide antibiotic used for selected bacterial infections and sometimes during pregnancy for toxoplasmosis. Choice depends on the infection, local guidance, pregnancy stage, allergies, resistance, and other treatment needs.

Spirillum Minus

Spirillum minus is a spiral Gram-negative bacterium that causes rat-bite fever, characterized by fever, rash, and migratory joint pain after rodent exposure; culture is difficult and diagnosis may be clinical or molecular.

Spirit

A volatile liquid preparation or alcohol; the meaning depends on the medical, pharmaceutical, or general context.

Spiritual Pain

Distress involving meaning, purpose, beliefs, identity, or connection, often addressed in palliative and supportive care.

Spirochaetaceae

A family of spiral-shaped bacteria that includes medically important spirochetes such as Borrelia, Treponema, and Leptospira.

Spirochaetales Infection

Infection caused by spiral-shaped bacteria in the order Spirochaetales, including syphilis, Lyme disease, relapsing fever, and leptospirosis.

Alternate Names:
Spirochaetal Infections; Spirochetal Infections

Spirochaete

Another spelling of spirochete, a thin, flexible, spiral-shaped bacterium. Important genera include Treponema, Borrelia, and Leptospira.

Spirochete

A thin, spiral-shaped bacterium that moves with a corkscrew-like motion. Important examples cause syphilis, Lyme disease, relapsing fever, and leptospirosis; diagnosis depends on the organism and may use blood tests or other samples.

Spirogram

A graph recording how much air a person breathes and how quickly it moves during a lung-function test. It helps identify patterns suggesting airway narrowing, restricted lung expansion, or poor effort.

Spirometer

An instrument that measures airflow and the volume of air moved during specified breathing maneuvers, especially forced expiration. It does not by itself measure all lung volumes; residual volume and total lung capacity require additional pulmonary-function testing.

Spirometry

A breathing test that measures how much air a person can blow out and how quickly. It helps identify narrowing of the airways, as in asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, and can monitor treatment. The person must follow instructions and blow forcefully several times; results are interpreted with age, height, and symptoms.

Spironolactone

A medicine that blocks aldosterone, a hormone that makes the kidneys retain salt and water. It helps the

body remove extra fluid while keeping potassium. It is used for heart failure, high blood pressure, excess aldosterone, and fluid buildup from some conditions. It can raise blood potassium to dangerous levels, especially with kidney disease or certain medicines, and may cause breast enlargement or menstrual changes.

Spirulina

Spirulina is a type of cyanobacterium sold as a dietary supplement. Products may provide nutrients, but contamination and medication interactions are possible, and it is not a reliable substitute for a balanced diet.

Spit

Saliva or other fluid expelled from the mouth. Increased saliva or repeated spitting may occur with mouth irritation, nausea, reflux, difficulty swallowing, medication effects, or habit.

Spitting

Forceful expulsion of saliva or other material from the mouth. New or excessive spitting may occur with oral disease, reflux, nausea, difficulty swallowing, medication effects, or habit.

Spitz Nevus

A benign melanocytic nevus, often a pink or pigmented papule in children or young adults, that may resemble melanoma clinically or histologically.

Spitz Nevus Pathology

A usually benign melanocytic proliferation composed of epithelioid or spindle cells, often symmetrical and well circumscribed, with maturation, Kamino bodies, and characteristic epidermal changes. Some lesions overlap morphologically with melanoma.

Splanchnic

Relating to internal organs, especially abdominal organs and their blood vessels or nerves. Splanchnic circulation supplies the digestive organs, while splanchnic nerves carry involuntary signals that regulate their function.

Splanchnic Ischemia

Inadequate blood flow to abdominal organs, usually involving the intestines and caused by arterial embolism, thrombosis, vasoconstriction, or severe low-flow states. It may produce abdominal pain, gastrointestinal bleeding, bowel injury, or organ dysfunction.

Splanchnic Nerve

A nerve carrying automatic signals between the spinal cord and internal organs, especially organs in the chest and abdomen. It helps regulate digestion, blood-vessel tone, and other functions that do not require conscious control.

Spleen

A lymphoid organ in the upper-left abdomen. Its red pulp filters blood and removes aged or abnormal blood cells; its white pulp supports immune responses. It also stores platelets and helps clear blood-borne microorganisms.

Spleen Development

The formation and maturation of the spleen before and after birth. The spleen gradually develops its blood-filtering and immune functions, including removal of aged blood cells and responses to germs in the bloodstream.

Spleen Diseases

Disorders affecting splenic structure or function, including splenomegaly, infarction, infection, cysts, abscess, rupture, vascular disease, and hematologic or infiltrative disorders.

Spleen Disorder

A disease affecting the spleen, such as enlargement, infection, infarction, rupture, inflammation, cyst, or tumor, with possible effects on blood cells and immunity.

Spleen Hemangioma

A spleen hemangioma is a usually benign blood-vessel tumor of the spleen, often incidental but occasionally associated with enlargement, anemia, or rupture risk.

Spleen Hilum

The indented area on the inner surface of the spleen where its blood vessels, nerves, and lymph vessels enter or leave. The splenic vein carries blood from the spleen toward the liver through the portal circulation.

Spleen Removal

Surgery to remove the spleen, which may be needed for injury, an enlarged or overactive spleen, blood disease, or a tumor. Without a spleen, the risk of severe infection increases, so vaccination and medical advice about fever are important.

Splenectomy

Surgical removal of the spleen, performed for selected traumatic, hematologic, malignant, vascular, or other disorders. It increases the risk of severe infection with encapsulated bacteria and requires preventive planning.

Splenic Abscess

A localized collection of pus in the spleen, usually from bloodstream infection, trauma, infarction, or spread from nearby disease and potentially causing fever, left-upper-quadrant pain, and sepsis.

Splenic Artery Aneurysm

An abnormal bulge in the artery that supplies the spleen. It often causes no symptoms, but rupture can cause life-threatening internal bleeding; risk is of particular concern during pregnancy.

Splenic Cyst

A fluid-filled lesion within the spleen, classified as true cysts with an epithelial lining, including congenital, epidermoid, and dermoid cysts, or pseudocysts without a lining, typically resulting from trauma, infection, or pancreatitis. Most are asymptomatic and discovered incidentally on imaging.

Splenic Flexure

The bend of the colon where the transverse colon becomes the descending colon, near the spleen.

Splenic Flexure Syndrome

Pain, fullness, or bloating in the upper-left abdomen caused by gas collecting at the bend where the transverse colon meets the descending colon. Symptoms may improve after passing gas or stool.

Splenic Infarction

Death of part of the spleen when its blood supply is blocked. It may cause sudden pain in the upper-left belly, sometimes spreading to the left shoulder, with nausea or fever. Causes include blood clots, sickle cell disease, heart or blood disorders, infections, inflammation of blood vessels, or injury. In some cases, an abscess or rupture can occur.

Splenic Infection

Infection of the spleen, often an abscess caused by bacteria spreading through the bloodstream or from nearby tissue. It may cause fever, chills, left-upper-abdominal pain, sepsis, or other severe illness.

Splenic Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the spleen. It may be noncancerous, cancerous, or cancer that has spread from another organ; symptoms and treatment depend on its type, size, and effect on nearby tissues or blood cells.

Splenic Rupture

A tear of the spleen, usually after blunt abdominal trauma but sometimes spontaneous in an enlarged or diseased spleen. It can cause life-threatening internal bleeding; diagnosis and treatment depend on hemodynamic stability and imaging, with urgent surgery or embolization sometimes required.

Splenomegaly

Abnormal enlargement of the spleen. It may result from infection, liver disease, blood disorders, cancer, or other conditions and may cause no symptoms. Some people feel fullness or pain in the upper-left abdomen. An enlarged spleen can trap blood cells and is more easily injured or ruptured.

Splenomegaly With Rheumatoid

Arthritis

Enlargement of the spleen occurring with rheumatoid arthritis, classically in Felty syndrome and sometimes with low white blood-cell counts. Infection risk and other causes of spleen enlargement may also be present.

Splenosis

Acquired growth of splenic tissue that implants outside the spleen, usually after splenic injury or splenectomy. Implants most often lie on abdominal or pelvic surfaces and can also occur in the chest after injury to the diaphragm. They are often found incidentally and can resemble tumors; unlike a congenital accessory spleen, splenosis results from displaced tissue.

Spliceosome

The spliceosome is a nuclear RNA-protein complex that removes introns from pre-messenger RNA and joins exons to form mature RNA.

Splice-Site Variant

A variant affecting the sequences required for accurate removal of introns and joining of exons during RNA processing. It may cause abnormal transcripts, exon skipping, intron retention, or reduced functional protein.

Splint

A rigid or flexible orthopedic device applied to an injured extremity or joint to provide non-circumferential immobilization, stabilization, and protection. Widely utilized in the acute management of fractures, sprains, dislocations, and deep soft-tissue trauma because unlike circumferential casts, splints permit acute tissue expansion and post-traumatic soft-tissue edema, substantially mitigating the risk of ischemic compartment syndrome and neurovascular compromise.

Alternate Names:
Splints

Splinter

A small piece of wood, glass, metal, or another material embedded in the skin. A deep fragment or one near an eye or joint can injure nearby structures; retained material may cause inflammation or infection.

Splinter Haemorrhage

Alternate spelling; see *Splinter Hemorrhage*.

Splinter Haemorrhages

Plural form; see *Splinter Hemorrhage*.

Splinter Hemorrhage

A tiny, longitudinal, dark red-to-brown linear streak appearing under the fingernails or toenails in the direction of nail growth, caused by extravasation of blood from damaged microvascular capillaries of the longitudinally oriented nail bed. While commonly produced by local trauma, multiple or proximal splinter hemorrhages are classic peripheral physical signs of infective endocarditis (microembolization or immune-complex vasculitis), antiphospholipid syndrome, and systemic vasculitis.

Alternate Names:
Splinter Hemorrhages; Splinter Haemorrhage; Splinter Haemorrhages

Splinter Hemorrhages

Plural form; see *Splinter Hemorrhage*.

Splinter Removal

Taking a piece of wood, metal, glass, or another material out of the skin. Small superficial splinters may be removed with clean tweezers, while deep, painful, infected, or eye- or nail-area splinters need clinical care.

Splints

Plural form; see *Splint*.

Split Brain

A state after surgical or pathological disruption of the corpus callosum in which information transfer between cerebral hemispheres is reduced, producing characteristic disconnection findings.

Split-Thickness Skin Graft

A surgical skin graft consisting of the entire epidermis and a variable portion of the underlying dermis harvested using a dermatome from a donor site (commonly the anterolateral thigh or buttocks). Categorized as thin, medium, or thick STSG, it is typically meshed to allow drainage and expand coverage area for large traumatic wounds, burns, or surgical defects; vascularization of the graft proceeds via serum imbibition, inosculation, and revascularization.

Alternate Names:
Split-Thickness Skin Grafts; STSG

Split-Thickness Skin Grafts

Plural form; see *Split-Thickness Skin Graft*.

Splitting

A psychological defense pattern in which a person or situation is viewed as entirely good or entirely bad, with difficulty integrating positive and negative qualities. It can occur in several mental-health conditions and is not diagnostic by itself.

Spondee

A two-syllable word with equal emphasis on both parts, used during speech-hearing tests. Examples help measure the quietest loudness at which a person can recognize spoken words accurately.

Spondylarthritis

A family of inflammatory rheumatic diseases affecting the spine, sacroiliac joints, entheses, peripheral joints, skin, eyes, or bowel, including ankylosing spondylitis and psoriatic arthritis.

Spondylitis

Inflammation of one or more vertebrae or parts of the spine. Causes include infection, autoimmune disease, and inflammatory arthritis; pain, stiffness, fever, or neurologic symptoms may occur.

Spondyloarthritis

A group of inflammatory joint diseases that often affect the spine and joints between the spine and pelvis. They may also cause tendon pain, swollen fingers or toes, eye inflammation, psoriasis, or bowel inflammation.

Spondylolisthesis

Slipping of one spinal bone forward or backward compared with the bone below it. It may cause back pain, stiffness, leg pain, numbness, or weakness, although some people have no symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Lumbosacral Spondylolisthesis

Spondylolysis

A small stress crack or defect in part of a spinal bone, usually in the lower back. It may cause back pain in adolescents or athletes and can sometimes allow one spinal bone to slip on another.

Alternate Names:
Lumbosacral Spondylolysis

Spondylosis

Wear-related changes in the bones, discs, and small joints of the spine. It becomes more common with age and may cause stiffness or pain, but many people have no symptoms; nerve pressure can cause numbness or weakness.

Sponge

A sponge is a porous material used to absorb fluid, clean or dress wounds, or deliver a product; retained surgical sponges are a preventable complication.

Spongiform Encephalopathy

A serious progressive brain disease in which brain tissue develops tiny sponge-like spaces. Prion diseases are important examples and can cause worsening memory, movement, coordination, behavior, and eventually loss of independence.

Spongy Bone

Porous trabecular bone found inside many bones, especially near joints.

Alternate Names:
Cancellous Bone; Trabecular Bone

Spontaneous Abortion

Unintentional loss of a pregnancy before fetal viability. Causes include chromosomal abnormalities, uterine or cervical problems, infection, and maternal medical conditions.

Alternate Names:
Early Pregnancy Loss; Spontaneous Pregnancy Loss

Spontaneous Bacterial Peritonitis

An infection of ascitic fluid without an identifiable abdominal source, usually occurring in people with cirrhosis and ascites. It may cause fever, abdominal pain, tenderness, or worsening illness. Diagnosis is made by testing ascitic fluid, usually showing at least 250 neutrophils per mm^3.

Spontaneous Bacterial Peritonitis Diagnostic Criteria

See *Spontaneous Bacterial Peritonitis*.

Alternate Names:
SBP Diagnostic Criteria; Ascitic Neutrophil Cutoff

Spontaneous Breathing Trial

A monitored period during which a person on a breathing machine does most of the breathing with little or no machine assistance. It helps clinicians judge whether the person may breathe safely after the tube is removed.

Spontaneous Coronary Artery Dissection

A tear within the wall of an artery supplying the heart, which can narrow or block blood flow and cause a heart attack. It often affects women and may be associated with pregnancy, severe stress, or fibromuscular dysplasia. Treatment depends on blood flow and stability; medicines or a stent may be used, and emergency care is needed for chest pain.

Alternate Names:
SCAD

Spontaneous Miscarriage

Pregnancy loss occurring without an intentional medical or surgical procedure.

Spontaneous Perforation

Unexpected rupture of a hollow organ without a clear external injury, allowing contents to escape and potentially causing peritonitis, mediastinitis, sepsis, or hemorrhage.

Spontaneous Pneumothorax

Air leaking into the space around a lung without a direct injury. It may occur in an otherwise healthy person or because of lung disease and can cause sudden chest pain or breathlessness.

Spontaneous Vaginal Delivery

Birth through the vagina without forceps or a vacuum device. It usually occurs during the second stage of labor as contractions and pushing move the baby through the birth canal.

Alternate Names:
SVD

Spoon-Shaped Nails

Alternate name; see *Koilonychia*.

Sporadic

Occurring irregularly or as an isolated case rather than in a predictable pattern or family cluster.

Sporothrix

A genus of environmental fungi that can cause sporotrichosis, usually after inoculation through the skin and sometimes through inhalation or dissemination.

Sporothrix Schenckii

A group of fungi that causes sporotrichosis, a typically nodular skin and lymphatic infection acquired from plants, soil, or animal scratches.

Sporotrichosis

A fungal infection caused by *Sporothrix* species, usually acquired when contaminated plant material or an infected animal inoculates the skin. The common lymphocutaneous form begins as a papule or ulcer and may produce a chain of nodules along lymphatic vessels. Less often, infection affects the

lungs, bones, joints, or other organs.

Sporozoa

An older group name for spore-forming protozoan parasites, including Plasmodium.

Sporozoites

Moving, infective forms produced by certain parasites. For example, mosquitoes inject Plasmodium sporozoites into people, after which they travel to the liver and begin the malaria infection cycle.

Sports Cardiology

A subspecialty of cardiology concerned with cardiovascular health in athletes and highly active people. It considers normal heart adaptations to training and cardiovascular disease in relation to exercise, including exercise-related symptoms, performance, and risk during sport.

Sports Cream Overdose

Excessive use or swallowing of a muscle or joint pain cream, often containing menthol, methyl salicylate, or capsaicin. It may cause skin burns, salicylate poisoning, vomiting, ringing ears, confusion, or seizures.

Sportsman's Groin

Long-lasting groin or lower-abdominal pain related to repeated sports activity, especially kicking, sprinting, twisting, or quick changes of direction. It is often called sports hernia, although there may be no true hernia. Examination and sometimes imaging help identify the cause; treatment may include rest, guided exercises, and, in selected persistent cases, surgery.

Alternate Names:
Athletic Pubalgia; Sports Hernia; Gilmore's Groin; Inguinal Disruption; Core Muscle Injury

Sports Medicine

Medical care focused on preventing, diagnosing, and treating exercise- and sports-related injuries and conditions. It also supports safe training, rehabilitation, performance, and return to activity.

Sports Physical

A preparticipation health evaluation that reviews medical history, symptoms, medications, family risks, and examination findings to identify conditions needing evaluation before sports.

Alternate Names:
Sports Physicals

Sports Rehabilitation

Treatment and training that help a person recover safe movement, strength, fitness, and confidence after a sports injury. It may include exercises, hands-on care, education, gradual return to activity, and steps to reduce the chance of another injury.

Spots Before The Eyes

Visual floaters, flashes, or scotomata perceived in the visual field; sudden onset can occur with retinal tear, detachment, or other urgent eye conditions.

Spots In Front Of The Eyes

Floaters or visual spots caused by shadows from vitreous opacities, inflammation, bleeding, retinal tears, migraine, or other eye or neurologic conditions; sudden flashes or a curtain-like loss are urgent.

Spotted Fever

A group of infections usually spread by ticks and caused by Rickettsia bacteria. They can produce fever, headache, rash, muscle aches, and serious illness requiring prompt diagnosis and antibiotic treatment.

Spousal Abuse

Spousal abuse is physical, sexual, emotional, financial, or coercive harm by an intimate partner; immediate safety planning and confidential support may be needed.

Spouse

A spouse is a person's legally or socially recognized partner; involving a spouse in healthcare requires the patient's consent unless law provides otherwise.

Sprain

An acute traumatic stretching, partial tearing, or complete rupture of one or more ligaments (fibrous connective tissue bands stabilizing a joint and connecting bone to bone). Graded from Grade I (mild microtears without joint instability), Grade II (partial tear with moderate laxity and pain), to Grade III (complete ligamentous disruption with gross articular instability). Common sites include the anterior talofibular ligament in the ankle and anterior cruciate ligament in the knee; management follows the PRICE protocol (protection, rest, ice, compression, elevation) and functional physical rehabilitation.

Alternate Names:
Sprains; Ligamentous Sprain

Sprained Ankle

Stretching or tearing of one or more ankle ligaments, usually after rolling the ankle inward. It may cause pain, swelling, bruising, and instability.

Sprains

Plural form; see *Sprain*.

Spray Drying

Spray drying converts a liquid mixture into a dry powder by atomizing it into a heated gas stream, often used in pharmaceutical and food manufacturing.

Sprengel Deformity

A birth difference in which one shoulder blade sits higher than usual because it did not move to its normal position during development. It may cause uneven shoulders, limited arm movement, or neck and back discomfort.

Spring Fever Henoch-Schonlein

Alternate name; see *Henoch-Schonlein Purpura*.

Sprue

A condition causing poor absorption of nutrients from the small intestine. The term may describe celiac disease or tropical sprue, which have different causes and require appropriate testing and treatment.

Spur Cell

Alternate name; see *Acanthocyte*.

Spur-Cell Hemolytic Anemia

A severe anemia in which abnormal, spiky red blood cells are rapidly removed from the blood, usually because of advanced liver disease. It can cause jaundice, weakness, and worsening anemia.

Spurling Test

A neck examination used when a pinched nerve is suspected. The clinician gently turns and tilts the neck and applies light downward pressure; pain or tingling traveling into the arm may support cervical nerve-root irritation.

Alternate Names:
Spurling's Maneuver; Cervical Foraminal Compression Test

Sputum

Mucus or other material brought up by coughing from the airways or lungs. Its amount, color, smell, and blood content may provide clues, but sputum alone cannot identify the cause; laboratory testing may be needed.

Sputum Culture

A laboratory test that grows germs from mucus coughed up from the lungs or collected by suction. It can help identify bacterial, fungal, or mycobacterial infection and guide treatment, but a poor sample can give misleading results.

Sputum Direct Fluorescent Antibody Test

A laboratory test that uses glowing antibody markers to look for selected germs in mucus from the lungs. It can provide a rapid result, but culture or molecular testing may also be needed.

Sputum Fungal Smear

Examination of coughed-up lung mucus under a

microscope to look for fungi. A culture, blood test, or molecular test may be needed to confirm the specific infection.

Sputum Gram Stain

A quick microscope test that colors a sputum sample to show some bacteria and inflammatory cells and to judge whether the sample is suitable for culture.

Sputum Stain For Mycobacteria

A microscope test that looks for tuberculosis-causing and related bacteria in mucus from the lungs. A positive result supports infection, but a negative result does not exclude it; culture or molecular testing may also be needed.

Squamous Cell

A flat, scale-like epithelial cell possessing a thin, polygonal shape with an attenuated central nucleus. Arranged as simple squamous epithelium (lining blood vessels as endothelium and body cavities as mesothelium, facilitating diffusion and filtration) or stratified squamous epithelium (lining the epidermis, oral cavity, esophagus, and cervix, providing a mechanical protective barrier against abrasion, microbial invasion, and water loss); malignant transformation gives rise to squamous cell carcinoma.

Alternate Names:
Squamous Cells

Squamous Cell Carcinoma

A cancer of flat cells that line the skin or certain body passages. On the skin it may appear as a rough, scaly, crusted, wart-like, or nonhealing sore and can invade nearby tissue or spread if untreated.

Squamous Cell Carcinoma in Situ

Squamous cell carcinoma in situ, also called Bowen disease, is an early skin cancer limited to the outer skin layer. It can become invasive if untreated.

Squamous Cell Carcinoma Of The Lung

A type of non-small-cell lung cancer that usually begins in the lining of a larger airway. It is strongly linked to smoking but can occur in nonsmokers. Symptoms may include a persistent cough, coughing blood, chest pain, breathlessness, or repeated chest infections; treatment depends on stage and tumor features.

Squamous Cell Carcinoma Of The Skin

Alternate name; see *Cutaneous Squamous Cell Carcinoma*.

Squamous Cells

Plural form; see *Squamous Cell*.

Squamous Cell Skin Cancer

Alternate name; see *Cutaneous Squamous Cell Carcinoma*.

Squamous Intraepithelial Lesion

An abnormal growth of squamous cells that remains within the surface lining of an organ. It may be low-grade or high-grade and commonly results from persistent infection with a high-risk human papillomavirus type; significance and progression risk depend on the site and grade.

Alternate Names:
SIL

Square Foot

A square foot is a unit of area equal to a square measuring one foot on each side, used to describe surfaces, rooms, wounds, or treatment areas.

Square Inch

A square inch is a unit of area equal to a square measuring one inch on each side, used for small surfaces or wound measurements.

Squint

Misalignment of the eyes so they do not point in the same direction. It may be constant or intermittent and can cause double vision, poor depth perception, or reduced vision in one eye.

SRT

Stereotactic radiotherapy, a precise form of external radiation treatment that uses three-dimensional imaging and careful positioning to target a small

tumor or other abnormal area. It is often given in two to five sessions to limit exposure to nearby tissue.

SSRI

A selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor; a widely prescribed class of medications commonly used to treat depression, anxiety disorders, and related conditions. They work by slowing the reabsorption of serotonin, a chemical messenger in the brain that helps regulate mood, emotion, and sleep. By allowing more serotonin to remain available between nerve cells, SSRIs help improve mood regulation and alleviate anxiety symptoms.

Alternate Names:
SSRIs; Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor; Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitors

SSRIs

Plural form; see *SSRI*.

Stable Angina

Repeated, predictable chest pressure or discomfort brought on by activity or stress because the heart muscle receives too little blood. It usually improves with rest or prescribed medicine; new, severe, prolonged, or rest pain may indicate unstable angina or a heart attack.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Stable Angina

Stable Coronary Artery Disease

Coronary artery narrowing causing a consistent, predictable pattern of angina.

Alternate Names:
Stable Ischemic Heart Disease

Stable Disease

An oncology response category in which a cancer has neither shrunk enough to meet criteria for partial response nor grown enough to meet criteria for progressive disease. It describes change over a specified assessment interval and does not mean that the cancer is cured or inactive.

Stabs

Brief, sharp pains or penetrating injuries described as stabbing. Causes vary with location and may include nerve irritation, muscle strain, infection, inflammation, injury, or serious disease.

Stab Wound

A deep puncture caused by a pointed or sharp object. The wound may damage blood vessels, nerves, organs, or bone even when the skin opening looks small; heavy bleeding, severe pain, or a chest or abdominal wound can indicate life-threatening internal injury.

Stafne Bone Defect

A Stafne bone defect is a usually harmless, developmental indentation in the lower jaw caused by nearby salivary-gland tissue. It is often found incidentally on imaging.

Stage 4 Prostate Cancer

Alternate name; see *Advanced Prostate Cancer*.

Stage I

A cancer stage that generally indicates limited disease, although the exact definition and prognosis depend on the cancer type and staging system.

Stage II

A cancer stage that usually indicates a larger or more locally advanced tumor than stage I, without distant spread. The exact tumor size, lymph-node findings, prognosis, and treatment vary by cancer type and staging system.

Stage III

A cancer stage that often indicates more extensive local or regional disease, with the precise criteria depending on the cancer type.

Stage IV

A cancer stage that generally indicates spread to distant organs or sites. Prognosis and treatment vary by cancer type and individual factors.

Stages Of Change

A model describing common steps people may pass through when changing a behavior. These include not yet considering change, thinking about it, preparing, taking action, and maintaining the change; people may move backward or forward between stages.

Alternate Names:
Transtheoretical Model; Prochaska Model

Stages of Labor

The three sequential stages of childbirth: the first stage extends from the onset of labor to complete cervical dilation and includes latent and active phases; the second stage extends from complete dilation to birth of the baby; and the third stage extends from birth to delivery of the placenta.

Staghorn Calculi

Large branching kidney stones that fill part or all of the kidney's urine-collecting system. They are often linked with infection, can damage kidney tissue, and usually require specialist treatment to remove them.

Staghorn Calculus

A branching kidney stone that fills part or all of the renal pelvis and calyces, often associated with infection.

Staging

Determining how far a cancer has grown or spread by assessing the original tumor, nearby lymph nodes, and distant organs. The stage helps estimate outlook and choose treatment.

Staining

A laboratory method that uses colored dyes to make cells, tissue structures, or microorganisms easier to see under a microscope. Different stains highlight different features and can help guide diagnosis, although results may need culture or other tests for confirmation.

Stainless Steel

A corrosion-resistant alloy containing iron and chromium, used for instruments, implants, orthodontic appliances, and some dental crowns. Its suitability depends on the grade, strength, and tissue exposure.

Stammering

Alternate name for stuttering, a speech-fluency difficulty involving repeated sounds or words, prolonged sounds, or blocks that interrupt speaking. It is common in childhood and may continue into adulthood; speech-language therapy can help.

Standard Deviation

A number that shows how widely measurements differ from their average. A small standard deviation means values are close together, while a large one means they are more spread out; it does not by itself show whether results are good or bad.

Standard Eye Exam

A comprehensive eye examination assessing visual acuity, refraction, pupils, eye movements, external structures, anterior eye, intraocular pressure, and ocular fundus as indicated.

Standardized Extract

An herbal extract adjusted to contain a measured amount of selected ingredient, improving consistency but not guaranteeing safety or effectiveness.

Standardized Uptake Value

A number used on a PET scan to estimate how much radioactive tracer a tissue has taken up, adjusted for the injected amount and body size. It can help compare areas or follow change, but it does not by itself prove cancer or another disease.

Standard Of Care

The conduct, skill, diligence, and judgment a reasonably prudent practitioner of the same specialty would exercise under similar circumstances; the benchmark for medical negligence. It is established through guidelines, peer practice, and expert testimony rather than fixed statute.

Standard Precautions

Basic infection-control measures used for every patient, because blood, body fluids, nonintact skin, and mucous membranes may carry germs. They include hand hygiene, appropriate protective equipment, safe injections, sharps safety, and respiratory etiquette.

Stannosis

A usually mild form of pneumoconiosis caused by long-term inhalation of tin oxide dust. It may produce visible lung changes on imaging, often without major breathing impairment.

Stanozolol

A synthetic anabolic androgenic steroid with limited medical use and potential liver, lipid, and cardiovascular toxicity.

Stapedectomy

Surgical removal or replacement of the stapes, usually to treat otosclerosis and conductive hearing loss.

Stapedius

A small middle-ear muscle that helps limit movement of the stapes and may protect the inner ear from loud sounds.

Stapes

The smallest middle-ear bone, passing sound vibrations from the incus to the inner ear for hearing.

Staph Infection

Alternate informal name; see *Staphylococcal Infection*.

Staph Infections In The Hospital

Infections caused by Staphylococcus bacteria that begin during or after healthcare treatment, or require hospital care. They may involve wounds, blood, lungs, bones, or devices and can be difficult to treat when the bacteria resist antibiotics.

Staphylococcal Food Poisoning

An acute foodborne intoxication caused by the ingestion of preformed heat-stable enterotoxins produced by Staphylococcus aureus in improperly refrigerated or handled foods (such as dairy products, pastries, processed meats, and salads). Characterized by an abrupt onset of severe nausea, spasmodic abdominal cramping, and violent vomiting within 1 to 6 hours of consumption, usually resolving spontaneously within 24 to 48 hours.

Alternate Names:
Staphylococcal Enterotoxicosis; Staph Food Poisoning

Staphylococcal Infection

An infection caused by Staphylococcus aureus or another Staphylococcus species. It may affect the skin, bone, joints, lungs, heart valves, blood, or other tissues. Some strains resist multiple antibiotics. Diagnosis and antimicrobial treatment depend on the site, severity, and susceptibility of the organism.

Alternate Names:
Staph Infection; Staphylococcal Disease

Staphylococcal Meningitis

Staphylococcal meningitis is infection and inflammation of the meninges caused by Staphylococcus bacteria, often after surgery, trauma, bloodstream infection, or an invasive device.

Staphylococcal Pneumonia

Pneumonia caused by Staphylococcus bacteria, sometimes after influenza or another viral infection. It may cause fever, cough, chest pain, breathlessness, lung abscesses, or infected fluid around the lung.

Staphylococcal Scalded Skin

Alternate name; see *Staphylococcal Scalded Skin Syndrome*.

Staphylococcal Scalded Skin Syndrome

A toxin-mediated skin disorder caused by Staphylococcus aureus, usually affecting infants or young children. It produces widespread redness, tenderness, fragile superficial blisters, and peeling that can

resemble a burn; extensive skin loss can cause fluid loss and infection.

Staphylococcus

A genus of gram-positive cocci that includes S. aureus and common skin colonizers and pathogens.

Staphylococcus Aureus

A bacterium that commonly lives on the skin or in the nose but can cause infections of the skin, blood, lungs, bones, joints, or heart valves. Some strains are resistant to several antibiotics.

Stapling

Closing or joining tissue with metal or absorbable surgical staples. Staples may be used for skin, blood vessels, or parts of the digestive tract; removal timing depends on the site and staple material.

Starch Poisoning

Illness after swallowing a starch product, most often causing choking, blockage, or stomach upset rather than systemic poisoning. Inhaled powder can irritate the airways; breathing difficulty or persistent vomiting can indicate aspiration or blockage.

Stargardt Disease

An inherited eye disorder that gradually damages the macula, the central part of the retina. It usually begins in childhood or young adulthood and causes loss of detailed central vision; side vision is often preserved.

Starling Equation

A mathematical physical equation describing the transcapillary fluid filtration rate (J_v) as a function of the hydraulic conductance and the balance between hydrostatic pressure gradients (capillary minus interstitial) and oncotic pressure gradients (capillary minus interstitial) across microvascular endothelia.

Starling Forces

The balance of pressures that pushes water out of small blood vessels or pulls it back in. Changes can cause swelling in tissues, dehydration of tissues, or fluid buildup around organs.

Starvation

Severe lack of food or usable energy over time, causing weight and muscle loss, weakness, changes in body chemistry, reduced immunity, and eventually organ failure. Restarting nutrition after prolonged starvation can trigger dangerous shifts in body salts and fluid balance.

Stasis

Slowing or stopping of normal movement of blood, lymph, intestinal contents, or other body fluids.

Stasis Dermatitis

Inflammation of the lower-leg skin caused by chronic venous hypertension and edema. It may cause itching, redness, scaling, brown discoloration, weeping, or ulcers around the ankles. Management focuses on treating venous disease, compression when safe, skin care, and evaluation for infection or arterial insufficiency.

Stasis Dermatitis And Ulcers

Stasis dermatitis and ulcers result from chronic venous hypertension in the lower legs, causing swelling, brown skin change, inflammation, itching, and slow-healing wounds.

Stasis Ulcer

A stasis ulcer is a chronic lower-leg wound caused by venous hypertension and poor return of blood, commonly near the ankle and associated with edema and skin changes.

STAT

A medical instruction meaning immediately or with urgent priority, such as a stat test, medicine, or consultation.

Statin

A widely prescribed class of medications that help lower blood cholesterol levels, particularly low-density lipoprotein (LDL) or "bad" cholesterol.

Statins work by blocking a specific liver enzyme that the body uses to make cholesterol, encouraging the liver to remove more existing cholesterol from the bloodstream. By reducing arterial cholesterol plaque buildup, statins help decrease the long-term risk of heart attacks and strokes in individuals with cardiovascular disease or elevated risk factors.

Alternate Names:
Statins; HMG-CoA Reductase Inhibitor; HMG-CoA Reductase Inhibitors

Statin Drugs

Alternate name; see *Statin*.

Statin-Induced Myopathy

Muscle disease attributed to statin therapy, typically involving muscle weakness or injury with elevated creatine kinase. Muscle aches or tenderness with normal creatine kinase are more broadly described as statin-associated muscle symptoms and do not alone establish myopathy; rare severe injury can progress to rhabdomyolysis and kidney damage.

Statins

Plural form; see *Statin*.

Statins In Diabetes

Cholesterol-lowering treatment for people with diabetes who may benefit from reduced risk of heart attack and stroke. The medicine and dose depend on age, cardiovascular risk, kidney function, other medicines, and possible side effects.

Station

A measure of how far the baby's presenting part, usually the head, has descended through the pelvis during labor. It is compared with the mother's pelvic bones and helps clinicians follow progress toward birth.

Status Asthmaticus

A severe asthma attack that does not improve enough with the first treatments. Breathing may become dangerously difficult, with exhaustion, inability to speak normally, or low oxygen, and emergency hospital treatment is required.

Status Epilepticus

A medical and neurological emergency in which an epileptic seizure lasts longer than 5 minutes, or multiple seizures occur in rapid succession without the person regaining normal consciousness in between. Because normal brain mechanisms fail to stop the continuous abnormal electrical discharges, prolonged seizure activity can lead to permanent brain damage, respiratory failure, or life-threatening systemic complications if not halted rapidly.

Alternate Names:
SE; Convulsive Status Epilepticus; Refractory Status Epilepticus

Status Migrainosus

A severe migraine attack that persists for more than 72 hours, often with persistent vomiting, dehydration, or medication overuse.

Stay Away From Asthma Triggers

Avoiding asthma triggers such as smoke, allergens, infections, fumes, and cold air can reduce symptoms and attacks, alongside prescribed controller and reliever treatment.

STDs

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Steady State

The point during regular medicine use when the amount entering the body over time is about equal to the amount leaving it. Blood levels then become relatively stable; reaching this point usually takes several doses and depends on the medicine's half-life.

Steal Syndrome

Reduced blood flow to a hand, foot, or other area because a bypass graft or dialysis fistula diverts too much blood. It may cause pain, coolness, pale or blue skin, numbness, or weakness and requires vascular assessment.

Steatocystoma Multiplex

A disorder producing multiple sebum-filled cysts arising from the pilosebaceous units, commonly on

the trunk, chest, arms, or face. Lesions are usually skin-colored and painless but may become inflamed; treatment depends on symptoms and extent.

Steatoma

A fatty or sebaceous mass; the term may refer to a lipoma or, in the ear, a cholesteatoma depending on context.

Steatorrhea

The passage of excess fat in the stool, causing greasy, pale, foul-smelling, floating stools—a hallmark of fat malabsorption.

Steatorrhoea

Excess fat in stool, causing pale, bulky, greasy, foul-smelling bowel movements. It suggests poor fat digestion or absorption from pancreatic, liver, bile-duct, intestinal, or other digestive disease.

Steatotic Liver Disease (SLD)

A group of liver disorders characterized by excess fat accumulation in liver cells. Causes include metabolic dysfunction, alcohol, medicines, and other conditions; inflammation, fibrosis, cirrhosis, or liver cancer may develop in some people.

Steele-Richardson-Olszewski Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Progressive Supranuclear Palsy*.

Stein-Leventhal Syndrome

Older name; see *Polycystic Ovary Syndrome*.

ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction

An acute myocardial infarction associated with characteristic ST-segment elevation on an electrocardiogram. The ECG pattern reflects acute myocardial ischemia but does not, by itself, prove complete coronary-artery blockage. Acute coronary occlusion may occur with or without ST elevation; myocardial infarction is established by evidence of acute myocardial injury together with evidence of ischemia.

Stem Cell

An undifferentiated or unspecialized biological cell possessing two defining properties: self-renewal (the capacity to undergo numerous rounds of cell division while maintaining the undifferentiated state) and potency (the capacity to differentiate into specialized cell types). Hierarchically classified into totipotent cells (capable of generating an entire organism and extraembryonic membranes), pluripotent cells (embryonic stem cells generating all three primary germ layers), and multipotent/unipotent adult somatic stem cells (e.g., hematopoietic stem cells in bone marrow replenishing blood cell lineages, and neural stem cells).

Alternate Names:
Stem Cells

Stem Cell Donation

The collection of healthy blood-forming stem cells from a donor for transplantation into another person. Cells may be collected from the bloodstream by apheresis after medication increases their number in the blood, or directly from bone marrow under anesthesia. Donor and recipient compatibility, especially human leukocyte antigen matching, helps improve transplant success.

Stem Cells

Plural form; see *Stem Cell*.

Stem Cell Transplantation

Hematopoietic stem cell transplantation replaces diseased or ablated bone marrow with healthy donor or autologous stem cells.

STEMI

A type of heart attack caused by sudden blockage of a heart artery, usually producing characteristic changes on an electrocardiogram. It is an emergency because quickly restoring blood flow can limit permanent heart damage.

Alternate Names:
ST-Elevation Myocardial Infarction

Stenosing Tenosynovitis

Alternate name; see *Trigger Finger*.

Stenosis

Abnormal narrowing of a passage, blood vessel, heart valve, spinal canal, or other opening. Narrowing may restrict flow or compress nearby structures.

Stenosis of the LAD

Narrowing of a major artery supplying the front of the heart. Reduced blood flow may cause chest pain during exertion or a heart attack if the narrowing becomes severe or the artery suddenly blocks.

Stenotic

Stenotic means narrowed, as in a stenotic heart valve, blood vessel, airway, intestine, or other passage.

Stenotrophomonas Maltophilia Resistance

The ability of Stenotrophomonas maltophilia bacteria to survive several antibiotics. Treatment depends on the infected body site, illness severity, and laboratory testing that identifies which medicines are likely to work.

Stensen Duct

The main excretory duct of the parotid gland that traverses the masseter muscle and opens into the oral cavity through a small papilla on the buccal mucosa opposite the second maxillary molar.

Alternate Names:
Parotid Duct; Stensen's Duct

Stent

A tube or scaffold placed inside a vessel or other passage to keep it open.

Stent Graft

A fabric-covered stent placed inside a blood vessel to reinforce the vessel wall or exclude an aneurysm from blood flow.

Stenting

Placement of a small mesh tube to keep a narrowed or blocked passage open. Vascular stents restore blood flow, while drug-coated types release medicine to reduce repeated narrowing.

Stent Placement

Insertion of a mesh tube or other support to keep a narrowed or blocked passage open. Stents may be used in arteries, bile ducts, ureters, airways, or the esophagus; bleeding, blockage, infection, movement, or repeated narrowing can occur.

Stent Restenosis

Re-narrowing of a blood vessel within or adjacent to a previously placed stent, usually caused by tissue growth, recurrent atherosclerosis, or thrombosis.

Stepping Reflex

A newborn reflex in which an infant held upright makes stepping-like movements when the soles touch a firm surface. It usually fades by about 2 months as the nervous system matures; later walking is a separate learned movement.

Stercoral Colitis

Inflammation and injury of the colon caused by hard, impacted stool pressing on the bowel wall, usually after prolonged constipation. The pressure can reduce blood flow and lead to ulcers or, in severe cases, a hole in the bowel.

Stereognosis

The ability to recognize a familiar object by feeling it without looking. It requires intact skin sensation, nerve pathways, and areas of the brain that interpret touch; loss may occur after nerve or brain injury.

Stereotactic

Stereotactic describes a technique using three-dimensional coordinates to target a precise location in the brain or another body structure.

Stereotactic Biopsy

Image-guided biopsy using three-dimensional coordinates to target a lesion that may be difficult to localize by direct palpation. It is used in the breast and, with specialized systems, the brain, lung, and other organs.

Stereotactic Body Radiation Therapy

A focused form of external radiation that delivers a high dose to a small body tumor in a few treatments. It may treat selected lung, liver, kidney, pancreatic, or spinal tumors while limiting exposure to nearby tissue.

Stereotactic Brain Biopsy

A precision, minimally invasive neurosurgical procedure used to safely obtain small tissue samples from deep, delicate, or high-risk areas of the brain for microscopic examination. Using high-resolution pre-operative MRI or CT scans and a specialized three-dimensional stereotactic head frame or frameless optical infrared navigation system, a neurosurgeon maps exact mathematical coordinates to the suspected tumor or infection. Through a tiny circular burr hole (approximately 3 to 5 mm) in the skull, the surgeon gently passes a specialized hollow biopsy needle straight to the target lesion without disrupting surrounding healthy brain tissue. The extracted tissue specimens are examined by a neuropathologist to determine the exact tumor type, grade, genetic markers, or underlying infection, allowing doctors to design targeted chemotherapy, radiation, or medical therapy.

Alternate Names:
Stereotactic Needle Biopsy; Brain Biopsy; Frameless Stereotactic Biopsy

Stereotactic Breast Biopsy

A minimally invasive percutaneous core-needle biopsy procedure utilizing digital mammographic triangulation from angled X-ray views to precisely target and sample nonpalpable microcalcifications or architectural distortions.

Alternate Names:
Stereotactic Breast Biopsy; Stereotactic Core Needle Biopsy; Mammographically Guided Breast Biopsy

Stereotactic Radiosurgery

A highly precise external radiation treatment that uses imaging and stereotactic positioning to aim one or a few high doses at a small target, usually in the brain. Despite its name, it does not involve an incision; focused beams limit radiation to nearby healthy tissue. It is used for selected brain tumors and other intracranial disorders.

Alternate Names:
Stereotaxic Radiosurgery

Stereotaxis

A technique using a three-dimensional coordinate system to target deep structures, especially in brain procedures.

Stereotypic Movement Disorder

Repeated, apparently purposeless movements such as hand flapping, rocking, or head banging that interfere with activities or cause injury. It is more common in childhood and developmental conditions; similar movements can have other neurologic or medical causes.

Sterile Field

A designated area maintained free of viable microorganisms during an invasive procedure. Only sterile equipment and materials may contact the field or the sterile portions of instruments.

Sterile Site

A body area or sample that normally contains no living microorganisms, such as blood, spinal fluid, joint fluid, or tissue from a closed space. Finding a germ there is usually important, although accidental contamination must be considered.

Sterile Technique

Methods used to prevent introduction of microorganisms into a sterile field, wound, tissue, device, or body site through hand hygiene, barriers, aseptic handling, and appropriate preparation.

Sterilisation

Destruction or removal of all forms of microbial life, or permanent contraception depending on context.

Sterility

Inability to reproduce, or complete absence of living microorganisms from an object or preparation, depending on context. In healthcare, sterile equip-

ment, implants, and medicines must remain free from contamination to prevent infection.

Sterilization

A process that destroys or removes all forms of microbial life, including spores, from equipment, medicines, or other materials. In another context, sterilization means a permanent method intended to prevent pregnancy.

Sternal Angle

The ridge where the manubrium joins the body of the sternum. It marks the level where the second ribs attach and helps locate structures inside the chest.

Sternal Exploration Or Closure

Surgical reopening or repair of the breastbone after median sternotomy, performed to treat infection, bleeding, instability, dehiscence, or other postoperative chest complications.

Sternal Fracture

A break in the breastbone, most often caused by direct chest impact or compression. It may cause localized pain and tenderness and can accompany cardiac, pulmonary, or mediastinal injury.

Sternal Line

An imaginary vertical line along the outer edge of the breastbone. It is used as a surface landmark when describing the location of chest structures or physical findings.

Sternal Tenderness

Pain when the breastbone is pressed. It can result from injury, inflammation, infection, or other chest-wall problems. Tenderness alone cannot rule out heart or lung causes of chest pain.

Sternoclavicular Joint

A saddle-type synovial joint between the clavicle and manubrium of the sternum. It is the only bony connection between the upper limb and axial skeleton and permits movement of the shoulder girdle.

Sternocleidomastoid Muscle

A prominent muscle on each side of the neck that turns and bends the head and helps stabilize the neck. It can also assist forceful breathing; strain or spasm may cause neck pain and limited movement.

Sternocleidomastoid Fibromatosis

A benign, firm thickening in a neck muscle, usually seen in infants during the first weeks of life. It may make the baby's head tilt to one side; the lump and tightness often improve with stretching and growth.

Sternocostal Joint

A joint where a rib or its cartilage meets the breastbone. These joints help form the front of the chest wall.

Sternotomy

Surgical division of the sternum, usually along the midline, to provide access to the heart or mediastinal structures.

Sternum

The breastbone forming the front of the central chest wall.

Sternutation

Sneezing, a reflex forceful expulsion of air through the nose and mouth triggered by irritation of nasal or upper-airway sensory receptors.

Steroid Myopathy

Muscle weakness caused by prolonged exposure to corticosteroid medicines or excessive cortisol. It usually develops gradually and affects the hips, thighs, shoulders, and upper arms, making it hard to rise from a chair or climb stairs. Weakness may improve when the cause is treated; abrupt steroid withdrawal can cause adrenal insufficiency.

Alternate Names:
Corticosteroid-Induced Myopathy; Glucocorticoid Myopathy

Steroids

A broad family of compounds with a characteris-

tic four-ring structure, including body hormones, corticosteroids, and sex hormones. Their effects depend on the type; prolonged corticosteroid use can suppress immunity and weaken bones.

Stertor

A low-pitched snoring, gurgling, or rattling sound caused by partly blocked air passages in the nose or throat. It may occur during sleep or illness; noisy breathing with severe sleepiness, blue lips, or breathing difficulty is an emergency.

Stethoscope

An instrument used for auscultation, the examination of sounds produced within the body. It usually has a chest piece with a diaphragm and sometimes a bell, flexible tubing, and earpieces; electronic models convert sounds into amplified or recorded signals. It is used to examine heart, lung, bowel, and vascular sounds.

Stevens Johnson Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Stevens-Johnson Syndrome*.

Stevens-Johnson Syndrome

A rare, severe, and life-threatening reaction that affects the skin and mucous membranes, most commonly triggered by an adverse reaction to certain medications (such as antibiotics, pain relievers, or anti-seizure drugs) or, less frequently, by infections. It typically begins with flu-like symptoms, followed days later by a painful red or purplish rash that spreads and blisters. The top layer of affected skin and the mucous membranes of the mouth, eyes, and genitals die and peel away, leaving raw, painful areas vulnerable to fluid loss and serious infection.

Alternate Names:
SJS; SJS/TEN Spectrum

Stewart-Treves Syndrome

An angiosarcoma arising in long-standing lymphedema, classically after mastectomy but also after congenital lymphedema, radiation, infection, or other lymphatic damage. It may appear as bruised, purple, nodular, or ulcerated areas in chronically swollen skin.

STI

Alternate name; see *Sexually Transmitted Disease*.

Stickler Syndrome

An inherited connective-tissue disorder that may cause severe nearsightedness, retinal detachment, hearing loss, early arthritis, and differences in the jaw or palate. Regular eye and hearing checks are important.

Stiff Baby Syndrome

A nonspecific description of unusual stiffness or increased muscle tone in an infant, not a single diagnosis. Causes include brain, nerve, muscle, genetic, or metabolic disorders; persistent stiffness, poor feeding, seizures, or breathing problems can indicate serious disease.

Stiffness

Difficulty or discomfort when moving a body part. It may result from joint disease, muscle problems, nerve disorders, inflammation, injury, prolonged rest, or aging and can limit everyday activities.

Stiff-Person Syndrome

A rare immune-related nervous-system disorder causing persistent muscle stiffness and sudden painful spasms. Noise, touch, movement, or emotional stress may trigger spasms, leading to falls and difficulty walking. Blood tests may find related antibodies. Treatment can reduce stiffness and immune activity, but symptoms often require long-term care.

Alternate Names:
SPS; Stiff-Man Syndrome; Moersch-Woltman Syndrome

Stigma

A mark, characteristic, or social discrediting label; in medicine it may refer to a sign or to harmful social attitudes.

Stilboestrol

Historical name; see *Diethylstilbestrol*.

Stilet

A thin, pointed instrument placed inside a cannula or tube to guide insertion, clear a blockage, or provide firmness. It can injure tissue or blood vessels if advanced beyond the device tip.

Stillbirth

The death of a fetus before or during delivery after the gestational-age or birth-weight threshold used by a country or health system. In the United States, it usually refers to loss at or after 20 weeks of pregnancy; the World Health Organization commonly uses 28 weeks for international comparisons. Causes may include problems with the placenta, fetal growth, infection, genetic or developmental conditions, or maternal illness, but some stillbirths remain unexplained.

Still Disease

An inflammatory disease that can affect the whole body. In children it is called systemic juvenile idiopathic arthritis; in adults it is called adult-onset Still disease. It can cause fever, joint pain or swelling, and a rash.

Alternate Names:
Systemic Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis; Adult-Onset Still Disease; AOSD

Still Disease-Associated Arthritis

Joint inflammation occurring in Still disease. In children, the related diagnosis is systemic juvenile idiopathic arthritis; in adults it is adult-onset Still disease.

Still's Disease

An inflammatory illness that can affect children or adults. It commonly causes repeated high fevers, a fleeting rash, joint pain or swelling, and marked inflammation; it can affect other organs and usually requires specialist treatment.

Still's Murmur

A common harmless heart murmur in children, usually heard between ages 2 and 7. It has a soft, musical sound, becomes louder with fever or exercise, and usually disappears as the child grows; the heart is otherwise normal.

Alternate Names:
Innocent Vibratory Murmur; Normal Pediatric Murmur; Twanging-String Murmur

Stimulant

A psychoactive substance that temporarily accelerates cognitive, physical, or behavioral activity by increasing sympathetic neurotransmission and central dopaminergic and noradrenergic activity. Pharmacologic stimulants (e.g., methylphenidate, amphetamine salts, modafinil) are used therapeutically for attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD) and narcolepsy; adverse effects and toxicity include tachycardia, hypertension, diaphoresis, insomnia, anorexia, psychomotor agitation, paranoia, and potential for dependence.

Alternate Names:
Stimulants; Psychostimulant; Central Nervous System Stimulant

Stimulants

Plural form; see *Stimulant*.

Stimulant Use Disorder

A pattern of using stimulant drugs that causes significant problems or loss of control despite harm. Stimulants include cocaine and amphetamine-type drugs; stopping may cause tiredness, low mood, increased appetite, or excessive sleep.

Stimulus

A stimulus is a physical, chemical, sensory, or social change that evokes a response from a cell, tissue, organism, or person.

Stingray

A sea-animal injury caused by a stingray spine, usually producing severe pain, swelling, and a puncture wound. Medical care may be needed to clean the wound, remove retained spines, and treat whole-body reactions.

Stings

Injuries caused when an insect, animal, or plant

injects venom or irritating material. They may cause pain, swelling, itching, allergic reactions, tissue damage, or serious poisoning depending on the source.

Stippling

Small marks around a firearm entrance wound caused by gunpowder striking the skin. The pattern may help estimate firing distance, but it varies with the weapon and ammunition and cannot establish distance by itself.

Alternate Names:
Gunpowder Stippling; Powder Tattooing

Stitch

A suture used to close tissue, or a sharp transient pain, often in the side during exercise.

St John's Wort

A herbal product made from Hypericum perforatum and sometimes used for depressive symptoms. It can cause side effects and reduce the effectiveness of many medicines, including some contraceptives, anticoagulants, transplant medicines, and HIV treatments.

Stochastic Effects

Possible effects of radiation, especially cancer or inherited genetic changes, whose chance increases with dose. The severity cannot be predicted from the dose, and even low exposure may carry some risk.

Stoddard Solvent Poisoning

Poisoning from Stoddard solvent, a petroleum-based cleaning solvent. Inhalation or swallowing can cause headache, dizziness, drowsiness, skin irritation, or aspiration-related lung injury; vomiting after ingestion can increase aspiration risk.

Stokes-Adams Disease

A syndrome of sudden fainting or near-fainting caused by transient severe slowing or interruption of the heartbeat, often associated with advanced atrioventricular block.

Stokes-Adams Syndrome

Sudden fainting caused by a temporary dangerous slowing or stopping of the heartbeat, often from heart block or another abnormal rhythm. It can cause injury or progress to cardiac arrest.

Stoma

A natural opening or a surgically created opening connecting an organ to the skin or another organ.

Stomach

The hollow, muscular organ between the oesophagus and small intestine. It stores and mixes food with acid and enzymes, begins protein digestion, and meters the resulting chyme into the duodenum, the first part of the small intestine. Gastric acid kills many ingested microbes and helps make dietary iron and some minerals available for absorption.

Stomach Cancer

Cancer that begins in the stomach, most often in gland-forming cells lining the stomach. Risk factors include Helicobacter pylori infection, smoking, chronic inflammation, certain foods, and inherited conditions; symptoms and treatment depend on type and stage.

Alternate Names:
Gastric Carcinoma

Stomach Cramps

Intermittent gripping or spasmodic upper-abdominal pain caused by gas, infection, indigestion, ulcer disease, gallbladder or pancreatic disease, obstruction, or other causes.

Stomach Diseases

Disorders affecting the stomach, including inflammation, ulcers, movement problems, blockage, bleeding, and tumors. Symptoms may include pain, nausea, vomiting, early fullness, weight loss, indigestion, or blood in vomit or stool.

Stomach Flu

A common informal term for viral gastroenteritis, an infection of the stomach and intestines caused by

viruses rather than influenza viruses. It may cause watery diarrhea, vomiting, abdominal cramps, fever, and dehydration; some infections cause few or no symptoms.

Stomach Pain

Discomfort in the upper abdomen. Causes range from indigestion and infection to ulcers, gallbladder disease, or pancreatitis; severe or persistent pain can occur with serious disease.

Stomach Paralysis

Stomach paralysis, or gastroparesis, is delayed emptying of stomach contents without obstruction, causing early fullness, nausea, vomiting, and bloating.

Stomach Tube

A tube passed through the mouth or nose into the stomach for drainage, feeding, sampling, or treatment.

Stomach Ulcer

See *Gastric Ulcer*.

Stomach Washout

A procedure that rinses and removes stomach contents through a tube. It is rarely used for selected serious poisonings because it can cause choking, lung injury, bleeding, or other complications.

Stoma Complications

Problems involving an opening made from the intestine or urinary tract to the skin. They include skin irritation, bleeding, retraction, prolapse, narrowing, blockage, high output, infection, and a parastomal hernia; sudden severe pain, color change, or no output can signal ischemia or blockage.

Stomatitis

Inflammation, soreness, redness, or ulcers of the lining of the mouth. Causes include infection, irritation, nutritional deficiency, medicines, and cancer treatment; severe cases can cause dehydration or difficulty eating and drinking.

Stomatodynia

Alternate name; see *Burning Mouth Syndrome*.

Stomatology

The field concerned with diseases of the mouth and oral cavity, including the oral mucosa and related structures. The term is used variably across health systems and may overlap with oral medicine.

Stone

A hard lump formed inside an organ or tube, commonly from mineral salts or other body substances. Stones may block flow, cause pain or infection, and occur in kidneys, gallbladder, or ducts.

Stonefish Sting

A puncture injury from the venomous spines of a stonefish, causing severe pain, swelling, bleeding, and sometimes weakness, breathing problems, or shock. Hot-water immersion may reduce pain, but severe poisoning can affect breathing and circulation.

Stool

The solid or semi-solid waste matter discharged from the gastrointestinal tract through the anus during defecation (feces). Composed of undigested dietary fiber and residue, water, sloughed intestinal mucosal epithelial cells, unabsorbed minerals, bile pigments (stercobilin giving the characteristic brown coloration), and a massive biomass of commensal bacteria. Clinical macroscopic and microscopic evaluation (such as the Bristol Stool Form Scale, fecal occult blood testing, and stool culture) provides diagnostic insight into gastrointestinal motility, malabsorption, and infection.

Alternate Names:
Stools; Feces; Excrement

Stool C Difficile Toxin

A stool test for harmful substances made by Clostridioides difficile bacteria. A positive result supports active infection when a person has compatible diarrhea, but bacteria can be present without causing illness.

Stool Culture

Laboratory growth and identification of bacteria from a stool specimen to investigate infectious diarrhea or intestinal infection. Results may include antimicrobial-susceptibility testing; some organisms can be present through colonization rather than causing symptoms.

Stool Examination

Laboratory analysis of a stool sample for blood, infection, parasites, inflammation, malabsorption, or other digestive abnormalities.

Stool Gram Stain

Microscopic examination of a stool specimen after Gram staining; it may provide limited information about bacterial flora or inflammatory cells but is not a general test for infectious diarrhea.

Stool Guaiac Test

A chemical fecal occult blood test that detects the peroxidase activity of heme in stool. Dietary factors, medicines, and specimen collection can affect results. It is a screening or detection test rather than a diagnosis; a positive result requires clinical follow-up and usually evaluation for a gastrointestinal source.

Stool Holding

Alternate name; see *Encopresis*.

Stool Occult Blood Test

Alternate name; see *Fecal Occult Blood Test*.

Stool Ova And Parasites Exam

Microscopic examination of stool for parasite eggs, cysts, larvae, or other forms, sometimes requiring multiple specimens to improve detection.

Stools

Plural form; see *Stool*.

Stools – Floating

Feces that remain on the water surface, often from trapped gas or diet but sometimes from excess fat in malabsorption; persistent greasy, pale, foul-smelling stool can indicate impaired fat absorption.

STOPP/START

A checklist used to review medicines in older adults. STOPP identifies medicines that may be inappropriate or harmful, while START identifies useful treatments that may have been missed; clinical judgment is still required.

Storage Diseases

A group of inherited metabolic disorders characterized by accumulation of substrates within cells due to specific enzyme deficiencies. Lysosomal storage diseases result from defects in lysosomal hydrolytic enzymes, leading to accumulation of undigested macromolecules within lysosomes.

Stork Bite

A stork bite is a common harmless pink birthmark, usually a nevus simplex on the forehead, eyelids, nose, or neck, that often fades during childhood.

Strabismus

A condition in which the eyes are not aligned and do not point in the same direction. One eye may turn inward, outward, upward, or downward. It may be constant or come and go. Strabismus can cause double vision in adults and may lead to amblyopia, or reduced vision in one eye, when it begins during childhood. Common types include esotropia, exotropia, hypertropia, and hypotropia.

Strabismus Surgery

Surgery that changes the position or tension of one or more extraocular muscles to improve eye alignment. It is also called eye-muscle surgery.

Alternate Names:
Squint Surgery; Eye Muscle Surgery; Extraocular Muscle Surgery

Straddle Injury

A direct blunt compressive trauma to the perineum occurring when a patient falls astride a hard, rigid object (such as a bicycle crossbar, fence, or beam), frequently causing crushing rupture of the anterior bulbous urethra beneath the pubic symphysis.

Straight Leg Raise Test

A provocative physical examination test for lumbosacral nerve root irritation (L4-S1, typically due to herniated intervertebral disc), in which the patient lies supine and the examiner passively elevates the extended lower extremity; reproduction of electric shooting radicular pain down the leg between 30 and 70 degrees indicates a positive result.

Alternate Names:
Lasegue Sign; SLR Test

Strain

In musculoskeletal medicine, an acute injury to a muscle or its attaching tendon resulting from excessive stretching, violent eccentric contraction, or tensile overload. Graded from Grade I (mild stretching with microscopic tearing), Grade II (partial structural disruption with weakness), to Grade III (complete muscle or tendon rupture). In microbiology, a strain denotes a specific genetic or phenotypically distinct lineage or isolate within a single biological species.

Alternate Names:
Strains; Muscle Strain

Strain Imaging

Ultrasound or magnetic-resonance imaging that measures how much tissue deforms during movement, especially how heart muscle shortens or thickens with each heartbeat. It can reveal early weakness even when the total amount of blood pumped appears normal.

Strains

Plural form; see *Strain*.

Strangulated Hernia

A hernia in which the blood supply to the trapped tissue is cut off, causing ischaemia and possible tissue death; it is a surgical emergency.

Strangulation

Compression of a body structure, especially the neck or a hernia, that compromises blood flow or airway.

Strangury

Painful, urgent, or difficult urination in which only small amounts of urine are passed. It may result from inflammation or irritation of the bladder or urethra, infection, stones, or obstruction.

Strapping

Application of adhesive tape or bandage to support, protect, or restrict movement of a body part.

Stratum Corneum

The outermost skin layer, made mainly of flattened dead cells filled with keratin. It forms a protective barrier that limits water loss and helps block chemicals, germs, and physical injury.

Strawberry Hemangioma

Alternate name; see *Hemangioma*.

Strawberry Tongue

A tongue that looks bright red and bumpy like a strawberry, often seen in childhood illnesses like scarlet fever or Kawasaki disease.

Strength

The ability of a muscle or group of muscles to produce force. Healthcare professionals may test strength by comparing movements against resistance; reduced strength can result from pain, poor effort, muscle disease, nerve problems, or brain injury.

Strength Testing

Assessment of how much force a muscle or muscle group can produce, using examination or equipment. It helps identify weakness and monitor recovery, progression, or response to treatment.

Strength Training

Exercise against resistance to improve muscle force, endurance, power, bone health, and function. Training programs vary in resistance, repetitions, frequency, and progression.

Alternate Names:
Resistance Training; Weight Training

Strep Throat

A bacterial infection of the throat and tonsils caused by group A Streptococcus, also called Streptococcus pyogenes. It commonly causes a sudden sore throat, pain when swallowing, fever, and swollen or red tonsils, sometimes with white patches.

Streptococcal Cellulitis With Lymphangitis

A streptococcal skin infection with inflammation spreading along nearby lymphatic vessels. Redness, warmth, pain, swelling, fever, and red streaks may occur; infection can spread to the blood.

Streptococcal Infection

An infection caused by gram-positive, catalase-negative cocci of the genus *Streptococcus*, classified by hemolytic pattern (alpha, beta, or gamma) and Lancefield cell-wall carbohydrate antigens. Group A Streptococcus (*S. pyogenes*, GAS) causes pharyngitis, impetigo, erysipelas, cellulitis, necrotizing fasciitis, and toxic shock syndrome, with immune-mediated nonsuppurative sequelae including acute rheumatic fever and poststreptococcal glomerulonephritis; Group B Streptococcus (*S. agalactiae*, GBS) causes neonatal sepsis and meningitis; *Streptococcus pneumoniae* is a leading cause of otitis media, community-acquired pneumonia, and bacterial meningitis.

Alternate Names:
Streptococcal Infections; Strep Infection

Streptococcal Infections

Plural form; see *Streptococcal Infection*.

Streptococcal Pharyngitis

Alternate name; see *Strep Throat*.

Streptococcal Screen

A streptococcal screen looks for group A Streptococcus, usually from a throat swab, to help diagnose strep throat.

Streptococcal Toxic Shock Syndrome

A fulminant, life-threatening invasive infection caused by Streptococcus pyogenes (group A Streptococcus) producing streptococcal pyrogenic exotoxins that act as superantigens. It is characterized by the sudden onset of hypotension, shock, and multiorgan failure, frequently in association with severe invasive soft-tissue infections such as necrotizing fasciitis; it carries an exceptionally high mortality rate.

Alternate Names:
STSS; Streptococcal TSS; Toxic Shock-Like Syndrome

Streptococcus

A group of round bacteria that can cause throat infections, pneumonia, skin infections, heart-valve infection, or serious bloodstream illness. Different species spread and respond to antibiotics differently, so testing may guide treatment.

Streptococcus Agalactiae

Group B Streptococcus, a bacterium that can live in the bowel or genital tract without causing symptoms. It can pass to a baby during birth and cause serious newborn infection, so pregnancy screening and preventive antibiotics are used when indicated.

Streptococcus pneumoniae

Streptococcus pneumoniae is a bacterium that can cause pneumonia, meningitis, ear infection, sinusitis, and bloodstream infection. Vaccination helps prevent serious disease.

Streptococcus Pyogenes

Group A Streptococcus, a bacterium that causes strep throat, scarlet fever, impetigo, cellulitis, and sometimes severe invasive infection. Untreated infection can occasionally lead to rheumatic fever or kidney inflammation.

Streptokinase

A thrombolytic protein that activates plasminogen and dissolves clots; use is limited by bleeding risk and alternatives.

Streptomycin

An injectable aminoglycoside antibiotic used for selected tuberculosis and other bacterial infections. It

can damage vestibular function and hearing, sometimes irreversibly, and may injure the kidneys. Toxicity risk is greater with impaired kidney function, high exposure, or prolonged treatment.

Stress

A physical and emotional response to perceived demands or threats. It can change heart rate, breathing, muscle tension, attention, sleep, and digestion; persistent or overwhelming stress may affect health.

Stress Cardiomyopathy

A temporary weakening of the heart muscle that often follows severe emotional or physical stress. It can cause chest pain, breathlessness, or fainting and may resemble a heart attack, even when no heart artery is blocked.

Stress Echocardiography

An ultrasound scan of the heart performed while the heart works harder through exercise or medicine. It looks for changes in heart-muscle movement that may suggest reduced blood flow.

Stress Fracture

An incomplete, microscopic fracture of bone resulting from repeated, subthreshold cyclic mechanical microtrauma and load that exceeds the normal repair and remodeling capacity of bone tissue (fatigue fracture in healthy bone, common in military recruits and runners affecting metatarsals, tibia, or fibula; or insufficiency fracture in abnormally demineralized osteoporotic bone). Presents with localized, insidious pain exacerbated by weight-bearing; initial plain radiographs may be normal, with MRI or nuclear bone scintigraphy offering high sensitivity for early diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Stress Fractures; Fatigue Fracture

Stress Fractures

Plural form; see *Stress Fracture*.

Stress Incontinence

Involuntary leakage of urine during activities that increase intra-abdominal pressure, such as coughing, sneezing, lifting, or exercise.

Stress Injuries

Tissue injuries caused by repeated loading or overuse without sufficient recovery. Examples include stress fractures, tendinopathy, and muscle strain.

Stressors

Events, conditions, or circumstances that trigger a physical or emotional stress response. Examples include illness, pain, sleep loss, trauma, work demands, and relationship difficulties.

Stress Related

Describes symptoms or health problems that are triggered or worsened by physical or emotional stress. Stress can affect sleep, pain, digestion, mood, heart rate, and blood pressure; similar symptoms can also have other causes.

Stress Response

Body changes that prepare a person to respond to a perceived threat or challenge. Hormones and nerve signals alter heart rate, breathing, blood flow, attention, digestion, immunity, and energy use.

Alternate Names:
Fight-or-Flight Response

Stress Shielding

Loss or weakening of bone next to an implant because the implant carries more force than the bone normally would. Over time, this can reduce bone density and affect how securely the implant stays in place.

Stress Tests

Diagnostic tests that assess organ function under controlled physical, pharmacologic, or physiologic stress, commonly evaluating the heart for inducible ischemia or abnormal rhythm.

Stress Ulcer Prophylaxis

Measures used to reduce the risk of stomach or duodenal bleeding in selected critically ill people. The need for treatment depends on bleeding risk,

other medicines, and the person's overall condition.

Stress Urinary Incontinence

Leakage of urine when coughing, sneezing, laughing, lifting, exercising, or otherwise increasing pressure inside the abdomen. It commonly results from weakness of the pelvic-floor muscles or the bladder outlet and can often be treated.

Stretch Mark

A linear cutaneous atrophic scar resulting from excessive dermal stretching and mechanical tension combined with hormonal influences (glucocorticoids) that rupture elastic fibers and collagen bundles in the reticular dermis. Initially presenting as erythematous, violaceous linear bands (striae rubrae) perpendicular to the direction of skin tension, they gradually mature over months into permanent, hypopigmented, depressed, atrophic lines (striae albae). Commonly associated with rapid pubertal growth spurts, pregnancy (striae gravidarum), obesity, and Cushing syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Stretch Marks; Striae; Striae Distensae

Stretch Marks

Plural form; see *Stretch Mark*.

Stretch Reflex

An automatic tightening of a muscle when it is suddenly stretched, such as the lower-leg movement after tapping the knee tendon. It helps maintain posture and provides information about nerve and spinal-cord function.

Stria

1. A line, stripe, ridge, or thin band that differs from the surrounding tissue; the plural is striae. 2. A stretch mark, a linear mark caused by changes in deeper skin layers, often during rapid growth or stretching.

Alternate Names:
Striae; Stretch Lines

Striae

Linear bands or streaks in the skin, commonly called stretch marks. They develop when deeper skin layers stretch or change rapidly during growth, pregnancy, weight change, muscle gain, or hormone treatment.

Striae Atrophicae

Thin, linear, slightly sunken bands of skin caused by changes in the deeper skin layer; commonly called stretch marks. They may be red or purple at first and later become pale.

Alternate Names:
Stretch Marks; Striae Distensae

Striae Distensae (Stretch Marks)

Linear bands caused by stretching and structural change in the dermis during growth, pregnancy, rapid weight change, muscle gain, or corticosteroid exposure. They may begin red or purple and later become pale and atrophic.

Striae Gravidarum

Linear stretch marks caused by changes in the deeper skin layer during pregnancy. They often appear on the abdomen, breasts, thighs, or buttocks. They may start pink, red, or purple and later become pale.

Striate

Marked with fine lines, bands, or grooves.

Stricture

An abnormal narrowing of a passage in the body, such as the esophagus, intestine, bile duct, or urethra. Scarring, inflammation, injury, surgery, or cancer may cause blockage and symptoms related to the affected organ.

Stridor

A harsh, high-pitched breathing sound caused by air squeezing through a narrowed windpipe or voice box. It is heard loudest over the neck and usually happens while breathing in. This makes it different from wheezing, which comes from inside the lungs

when breathing out. In babies and young children, common causes include croup, an object stuck in the throat, or floppy airway cartilage. In adults, causes include severe allergic swelling, vocal-cord problems, infections, or growths in the neck. Doctors find the cause by checking oxygen levels, taking neck X-rays, or looking into the throat with a tiny camera.

String Sign

A very narrow, thread-like passage seen on an imaging test of the digestive tract. It may occur with narrowing from Crohn disease or with narrowing at the stomach outlet in an infant, but it is not specific to one condition.

String Test For Intestinal Parasites

A string test collects a sample from the upper digestive tract on a swallowed capsule and string to look for selected intestinal parasites.

Stripping of Membranes

A procedure in which a clinician sweeps a finger around the cervix to separate the membranes from the lower uterus. This may help start labor by encouraging the body to release natural labor-promoting substances; cramping or light bleeding can occur.

Alternate Names:
Membrane Sweeping; Cervical Sweep

Stroke

A life-threatening medical emergency that occurs when blood flow to a part of the brain is suddenly cut off or reduced, depriving brain cells of oxygen and nutrients. This can happen either because a blood clot blocks an artery supplying blood to the brain (ischemic stroke, the most common type) or because a weakened blood vessel bursts and bleeds into brain tissue (hemorrhagic stroke). Without oxygen, affected brain cells begin to die within minutes, causing sudden symptoms such as facial drooping, arm or leg weakness on one side of the body, difficulty speaking or understanding speech, vision loss, or balance problems.

Alternate Names:
CVA; Cerebrovascular Accident; Brain Attack

Stroke Index

A measure of the amount of blood pumped by the heart with each beat, adjusted for body-surface area. It helps assess heart function and is interpreted with other examination, imaging, and hemodynamic findings.

Stroke Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation after a stroke helps improve movement, speech, swallowing, thinking, mood, and daily activities while reducing complications and preventing another stroke.

Stroke Risk Factors

Stroke risk factors include high blood pressure, smoking, diabetes, high cholesterol, atrial fibrillation, prior stroke, and certain blood or vascular disorders.

Stroke Volume

The volume of blood ejected by the left ventricle with each heartbeat, normally 60-100 mL. It is determined by three factors: preload, afterload, and myocardial contractility. Stroke volume equals end-diastolic volume minus end-systolic volume. Reduced stroke volume occurs in heart failure, hypovolemia, and cardiogenic shock.

Stroma

The supporting tissue of an organ that surrounds and holds its working cells. It may contain connective tissue, blood vessels, nerves, and immune cells; the exact structure and role vary between organs.

Strongyloides Stercoralis

A soil-transmitted roundworm that can enter through skin and live in the human intestine. Infection may cause rash, abdominal symptoms, or no symptoms, but severe hyperinfection can occur when immunity is weakened.

Strongyloidiasis

An intestinal worm infection that can spread throughout the body and become life-threatening when immunity is weakened.

Structured Reporting

Reporting that uses a standard format, headings, and required fields to organize findings. It can improve completeness, consistency, and communication in imaging, pathology, and other clinical reports, but does not replace professional judgment.

Struma Ovarii

A specialized mature ovarian teratoma composed predominantly of thyroid tissue; it may be hormonally active or develop malignant thyroid-type transformation.

Struvite Stones

Kidney or urinary-tract stones formed during infection with certain bacteria. They can grow into large branching stones that fill the kidney and may damage it or block urine flow.

Strychnine

A poison causing severe painful muscle spasms and convulsions while awareness may remain; emergency treatment is required.

ST Segment

The part of an electrocardiogram between the electrical activation and recovery signals of the heart's lower chambers. Abnormal elevation or depression can occur with a heart attack, inflammation, or other conditions and is not specific to one cause.

ST-Segment Elevation

Elevation of the ECG ST segment above the isoelectric baseline, reflecting abnormal ventricular repolarization. It may indicate acute coronary occlusion but can also occur in pericarditis, early repolarization, ventricular aneurysm, or other conditions; interpretation requires clinical context and serial testing.

Stucco Keratosis

Multiple small, rough, whitish or gray-brown keratotic papules, usually on the lower legs and sometimes the arms or trunk of older adults. They are benign and may be treated for cosmetic or symptomatic reasons.

Student's Elbow

Olecranon bursitis, an inflammation of the bursa over the point of the elbow, often related to repeated pressure or trauma.

Stuffy Nose

Blocked or difficult nasal breathing caused by swollen tissue, mucus, allergy, infection, irritants, or structural narrowing.

Stuffy Or Runny Nose – Adult

A stuffy or runny nose in an adult commonly results from viral infection, allergy, irritants, or sinus disease; persistent, severe, bloody, or one-sided symptoms need review.

Stump Pain

Alternate name; see *Residual Limb Pain*.

Stunted Growth

Height substantially below expected levels for age, often due to long-term undernutrition, chronic illness, infection, or other factors.

Stupor

A state of reduced consciousness in which the patient is unresponsive to most environmental stimuli but can be temporarily aroused by vigorous, repeated stimulation (painful stimuli, loud shouting).

Sturge-Weber Syndrome

A condition present from birth involving abnormal blood vessels in the skin and sometimes on the surface of the brain. It may cause a port-wine birthmark, seizures, weakness, headaches, developmental problems, or glaucoma, depending on which areas are affected.

Stutter

Stuttering is a speech-fluency disorder involving repetitions, prolongations, or blocks in speech. Speech-language therapy can improve communication and confidence.

Stuttering

A speech-flow problem involving repeated sounds or words, stretched sounds, pauses, or blocks when speaking. It is not caused by low intelligence; support may include speech therapy, communication strategies, and help with anxiety or teasing.

St Vitus's Dance

An older name for Sydenham chorea, involuntary movements following group A streptococcal infection.

Sty

Alternate name; see *Stye*.

Stye

A tender, localized infection or inflammation of an eyelid gland, usually producing a painful red lump near the eyelid margin.

Alternate Names:
Hordeolum

Styptics

Substances that help stop minor surface bleeding by tightening tissue, narrowing small blood vessels, or supporting clot formation. They are used for limited bleeding and do not replace emergency care for severe blood loss.

Subacromial Pain Syndrome

A clinical term for non-traumatic pain around the subacromial region of the shoulder, usually worse when raising the arm. It may involve rotator-cuff tendinopathy, bursitis, or related disorders; no single examination finding establishes the cause.

Subacute

Describes a disease or process that develops or lasts longer than an acute one but is not chronic. It has no fixed time range; the duration meant should be specified for the condition being described.

Subacute Bacterial Endocarditis

Older term for subacute infective endocarditis, a slowly developing infection of the heart's inner lining, usually involving a valve. It is most often caused by bacteria, but other organisms can also cause it. Symptoms may include fever, tiredness, weight loss, a new murmur, or complications from infected material travelling in the blood; see *Infective Endocarditis*.

Subacute Combined Degeneration

Damage to parts of the spinal cord, usually from vitamin B12 deficiency. It can cause numbness, weakness, poor balance, and difficulty walking.

Subacute Combined Degeneration Of The Cord

Damage to the spinal cord, usually caused by vitamin B12 deficiency, affecting nerve pathways for vibration, position sense, and movement. It may cause tingling, weakness, poor balance, or difficulty walking and can become permanent without treatment.

Subacute Cutaneous Lupus Erythematosus (SCLE)

A photosensitive form of cutaneous lupus causing annular or papulosquamous red scaly lesions on sun-exposed skin. It may be associated with anti-Ro/SSA antibodies, medicines, or systemic lupus features and needs sun protection and medical evaluation.

Subacute Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided after the early phase of illness or injury for people who still need nursing care and therapy but no longer need intensive hospital treatment. It may occur in a specialized facility or outpatient setting.

Subacute Sclerosing Panencephalitis

A rare, progressive brain disease caused by measles virus remaining in the brain years after the original infection. It can cause behavior or learning changes, jerking movements, seizures, loss of coordination, and severe disability; prevention depends on measles vaccination.

Subacute Thyroiditis

Temporary inflammation of the thyroid, often after a viral illness, causing painful neck swelling, fever, and tiredness. Thyroid hormone levels may first be high and later low before returning to normal; treatment relieves pain and other symptoms.

Subaortic Stenosis

Narrowing just below the aortic valve that obstructs blood leaving the heart. It may cause a heart murmur, chest pain, fainting, breathlessness, or damage to the aortic valve and sometimes requires surgery.

Subarachnoid

Situated beneath the arachnoid, one of the thin coverings around the brain and spinal cord. The subarachnoid area contains protective fluid and blood vessels; bleeding there can cause a sudden severe headache and is an emergency.

Subarachnoid Cisterns

Anatomical enlargements and pools of the subarachnoid space formed where the arachnoid membrane bridges over deep depressions between the brain and skull, filled with cerebrospinal fluid, including the cisterna magna, interpeduncular cistern, ambient cistern, and chiasmatic cistern.

Subarachnoid Haemorrhage

Bleeding into the space around the brain containing cerebrospinal fluid, often causing sudden severe headache.

Subarachnoid Hemorrhage

A life-threatening type of stroke characterized by sudden bleeding into the subarachnoid space—the fluid-filled area surrounding the brain between the brain's protective inner membranes. It is most frequently caused by the sudden rupture of a brain aneurysm (a weakened, bulging spot in a cerebral artery) or by severe head trauma. It classically causes a sudden, excruciating headache, often described as the "worst headache of one's life" (thunderclap headache), rapidly accompanied by neck stiffness, nausea, light sensitivity, and loss of consciousness.

Alternate Names:
SAH; Aneurysmal Subarachnoid Hemorrhage

Subarachnoid Space

The space between two thin coverings of the brain and spinal cord, called the arachnoid and pia mater. It contains cerebrospinal fluid and blood vessels and helps cushion the nervous system.

Subareolar Abscess

A pus-filled infection beneath the areola, often associated with periductal inflammation and smoking, causing a painful lump, redness, drainage, or recurrent fistula.

Subchorionic Hemorrhage

Bleeding between the chorion and the uterine wall caused by partial separation of the gestational sac membranes. It may produce vaginal bleeding in early or mid-pregnancy and is assessed according to bleeding, gestational age, and ultrasound findings.

Subclavian

Relating to structures beneath the clavicle, especially the subclavian arteries and veins that supply or drain the upper limbs.

Subclavian Arteries

Paired arteries arising near the base of the neck that supply the upper limbs and give branches to the neck, chest wall, and brain circulation.

Subclavian Artery

A major artery beneath the collarbone that supplies the arm and contributes blood flow to the neck, chest, and brain. Narrowing or blockage can cause arm pain, weakness, or symptoms from reduced blood flow to the brain.

Subclavian Steal Syndrome

A condition in which narrowing of an artery supplying the arm redirects blood away from the back of the brain, especially during arm exercise. It may cause arm pain or weakness, dizziness, fainting, blurred vision, or imbalance. Treatment controls

vascular risk factors and may restore blood flow when symptoms are significant.

Subclavian Vein

The continuation of the axillary vein beyond the lateral border of the first rib. It joins the internal jugular vein behind the sternoclavicular joint to form the brachiocephalic vein.

Subclavian Vein Thrombosis

A blood clot in the large vein beneath the collarbone. It may be related to a central venous catheter or pacemaker lead, or to repeated strenuous arm activity and compression at the thoracic outlet (Paget-Schroetter syndrome). It can cause arm or neck swelling, pain, bluish discoloration, and pulmonary embolism.

Subclinical

Present without clear symptoms or signs that a person or clinician can notice. A subclinical problem may be found through a blood test, scan, screening examination, or other test and may or may not later cause symptoms.

Subclinical Disease

Disease that produces no obvious symptoms or signs but can be detected by screening, examination, or laboratory testing. It may remain mild or later become clinically apparent, depending on the condition.

Subclinical Hypothyroidism

A laboratory pattern in which thyroid-stimulating hormone (TSH) is higher than normal while free thyroxine (T4) remains within its reference range. Many people have no symptoms; some develop overt hypothyroidism, especially when thyroid antibodies are present. Follow-up or treatment depends on the TSH level, age, symptoms, pregnancy status, and other health factors.

Alternate Names:
Mild Thyroid Failure Subclinical Thyroid Failure Compensated Hypothyroidism

Subclinical Infection

An infection that produces no noticeable symptoms or signs but may still be detectable by testing and may sometimes be transmissible.

Subconjunctival Hemorrhage

A small blood vessel broken beneath the clear surface of the eye, causing a sharply demarcated red patch that usually resolves without treatment.

Alternate Names:
Hyposphagma; Eye Capillary Bleed

Subconscious

Mental processes outside immediate awareness; it is a psychological term rather than a specific diagnosis.

Subcorneal Pustular Dermatosis

A rare recurring skin disorder causing shallow, non-infectious pus-filled blisters just beneath the outer skin layer, usually on the trunk or skin folds. It may resemble psoriasis and can be associated with blood or immune disorders.

Subcortical Dementia

Cognitive decline associated predominantly with disease of structures beneath the cerebral cortex, often causing slowed thinking, executive dysfunction, mood change, gait problems, and impaired attention. Causes include small-vessel disease and some neurodegenerative disorders.

Subcortical Ischemic Vascular Disease

Chronic small-vessel disease causing reduced blood flow and tissue injury in deep brain structures. It may contribute to slowed thinking, gait difficulty, mood symptoms, urinary problems, and vascular dementia.

Subcu

Subcu is an abbreviation for subcutaneous, meaning beneath the skin; clear clinical instructions should spell out the route.

Subculture

The transfer of microorganisms from one culture

to fresh culture medium, used to maintain pure cultures, isolate colonies, increase viability, prepare standardized inocula, and perform identification/susceptibility testing. On solid media, subculture aims to obtain isolated single colonies from a mixed or stock culture.

Subcutaneous

Subcutaneous means beneath the skin; injections by this route deliver medicine into the fatty tissue between skin and muscle.

Subcutaneous Dirofilariasis

A rare zoonotic infection caused by mosquito-transmitted *Dirofilaria* roundworms, most often *D. repens*. It usually forms a localized nodule or slowly migrating swelling beneath the skin. Humans are accidental hosts, and the worms usually do not reproduce in them; diagnosis is generally made by identifying the parasite in a tissue sample.

Subcutaneous Emphysema

Air trapped beneath the skin, often after chest injury, surgery, a punctured lung, or a breathing procedure. It may cause swelling and a crackling feeling; rapid spread or breathing difficulty can indicate a serious underlying air leak.

Subcutaneous Implantable Cardioverter-Defibrillator

A device placed under the skin that detects and treats dangerous fast heart rhythms with an electrical shock. Its wires run outside the heart and blood vessels; infection, inappropriate shocks, movement, or device failure are possible.

Subcutaneous Injections

Administration of a medicine into the fatty tissue beneath the skin, commonly used for insulin, anticoagulants, and selected biologic medicines.

Subcutaneous Layer

The tissue layer beneath the dermis, made mainly of fat and connective tissue. It cushions deeper structures, insulates the body, stores energy, and contains larger blood vessels and nerves.

Subcutaneous Tissue

The layer beneath the skin that connects it to deeper structures. It contains fat, connective tissue, larger blood vessels, and nerves and provides insulation, cushioning, and energy storage.

Subdural

Located beneath the dura, one of the protective coverings around the brain and spinal cord. A subdural hematoma is bleeding in this space, often after head injury, and may cause headache, vomiting, confusion, weakness, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Subdural Effusion

Accumulation of usually clear fluid in the subdural space, often after trauma, surgery, infection, or cerebrospinal-fluid disturbance and sometimes causing headache or pressure effects.

Subdural Haematoma

A collection of blood between protective coverings of the brain, usually after small veins tear during a head injury. It may develop suddenly or gradually and cause headache, confusion, drowsiness, weakness, seizures, or loss of consciousness.

Subdural Hematoma

A collection of blood between two protective coverings of the brain, usually after small veins tear during a head injury. It can cause headache, confusion, weakness, seizures, sleepiness, or death.

Subdural Hemorrhage

Bleeding between two protective coverings of the brain, usually after tearing of small veins during a head injury. It may cause sudden or gradually worsening headache, confusion, drowsiness, weakness, seizures, or loss of consciousness and is diagnosed with brain imaging.

Subendocardial Myocytes

Heart-muscle cells in the inner layer of the myocardium, which are especially vulnerable to reduced blood flow.

Subendocardial Sclerosis

Fibrous thickening of the inner lining of the heart, often involving the ventricles or valves. Its significance depends on the cause and may include effects on filling, conduction, or cardiac function.

Subependymal Giant Cell Astrocytoma

A usually slow-growing brain tumor that develops near a passage where fluid leaves the brain's cavities. It is strongly associated with tuberous sclerosis and can block fluid flow, causing headache, vomiting, or enlarged brain cavities.

Subependymoma

A rare, usually benign slow-growing ependymal tumor, commonly arising in the ventricular system of adults. Symptoms result from obstruction of cerebrospinal-fluid pathways or incidental detection.

Subfertility

Alternate name; see *Infertility*.

Subgaleal Hematoma

A dangerous collection of blood within the loose areolar connective tissue space between the epicranial aponeurosis (galea aponeurotica) and the cranial periosteum, capable of crossing suture lines and expanding massively across the entire cranial vault, causing hypovolemic shock in neonates following vacuum-assisted delivery.

Subgaleal Hemorrhage

A potentially life-threatening accumulation of blood in the space beneath the scalp's epicranial aponeurosis. It can expand rapidly in a newborn, particularly after vacuum-assisted delivery, and requires urgent recognition and treatment.

Subinvolution

Slower-than-expected return of an organ to its usual size, especially the uterus after childbirth. It may cause prolonged or heavy bleeding, pelvic pain, or an enlarged tender uterus and can result from retained tissue, infection, or other causes.

Subjacent

An anatomical term describing a structure, tissue, or lesion located beneath another structure. It indicates relative position and does not necessarily mean that the two structures are touching; the relationship may be described on physical examination, imaging, or during surgery.

Subjective

Based on a person's own experience or report rather than a directly measured finding. Pain, nausea, fatigue, dizziness, and mood are subjective symptoms, while temperature and blood pressure are objective measurements.

Sublimation

A psychological defense process in which unacceptable impulses are redirected into socially acceptable activity; in chemistry it is solid-to-gas transition.

Sublingual

Sublingual means beneath the tongue; medicines given this way can be absorbed through oral mucosa and may bypass much first-pass liver metabolism.

Sublingual Epidermoid Cyst

A benign cyst lined by stratified squamous epithelium beneath the tongue mucosa, presenting as a slow-growing midline swelling that may require surgical excision if symptomatic.

Sublingual Gland

One of the paired major salivary glands, located beneath the tongue. It produces mainly mucous saliva that enters the mouth through several small ducts and helps lubricate the oral cavity.

Subluxation

Partial displacement of a joint in which some contact between the joint surfaces remains. It may cause pain, swelling, instability, limited movement, nerve injury, or repeated episodes after injury or disease.

Submandibular Gland

One of the major salivary glands, located beneath

the lower jaw. It makes much of the saliva present when a person is not eating and releases it into the floor of the mouth through a small duct.

Submucosa

The supportive layer beneath the moist lining of organs such as the intestine, airway, and bladder. It contains blood vessels, nerves, glands, and connective tissue and helps nourish and anchor the lining.

Subphrenic Abscess

A collection of pus beneath the diaphragm, usually caused by infection after abdominal surgery, a burst abdominal organ, or spread from nearby tissue. It may cause fever, upper-abdominal or shoulder pain, breathing discomfort, and sepsis and usually needs drainage and antibiotics.

Subq

Subq is an abbreviation for subcutaneous, referring to tissue beneath the skin and the route used for some injections.

Subscapular Artery

A branch of the axillary artery that supplies the shoulder blade region, chest wall, and nearby muscles. It contributes to the network of vessels supporting the shoulder and upper limb.

Substance

A substance is a material with defined or variable chemical composition; medical effects depend on identity, dose, route, duration, and host factors.

Substance Abuse

Legacy, nonspecific label; see *Substance Use Disorder*.

Substance Abuse Disorder

Legacy label; see *Substance Use Disorder*.

Substance Abuse Psychiatry

An older term for the clinical specialty concerned with substance use disorders and co-occurring mental-health conditions. Current terminology generally uses *Addiction Psychiatry* or *Addiction Medicine*.

Substance Dependence

A state in which repeated substance use produces physiologic adaptation, so that reducing or stopping the substance may cause withdrawal. It is distinct from, but may occur with, substance-use disorder.

Substance Intoxication

A temporary change in thinking, behavior, or body function caused by recent use of alcohol, a drug, or another substance. Effects depend on the substance, amount, timing, combinations, and the person's health.

Substance Use

The consumption of alcohol, tobacco or nicotine, cannabis, prescription or nonprescription drugs, inhalants, or other psychoactive substances. Use may be occasional, prescribed, nonmedical, or associated with a substance use disorder; the term alone does not imply harmful use.

Substance Use Disorder

A clinically significant pattern of alcohol, tobacco or nicotine, cannabis, prescription or nonprescription drug, inhalant, or other psychoactive-substance use that causes impaired control, social or occupational impairment, risky use, or clinically significant distress. Features may include craving, unsuccessful efforts to reduce or stop use, substantial time spent obtaining or using the substance, failure to meet major responsibilities, continued use despite harm, tolerance, or withdrawal; tolerance and withdrawal are not required.

Alternate Names:
Drug Addiction; Chemical Dependency; Substance Abuse Disorder

Substance Use In Pregnancy

Use of alcohol, tobacco or nicotine, cannabis, opioids, cocaine, or other substances during pregnancy. Effects depend on the substance, dose, timing, route, and other factors and may include maternal com-

plications, impaired fetal growth, preterm birth, or neonatal withdrawal.

Substance Withdrawal

Physical or mental symptoms that occur after reducing or stopping heavy or prolonged substance use. Symptoms range from anxiety and nausea to seizures, severe confusion, dangerous blood-pressure changes, or breathing problems, depending on the substance.

Substance-Induced Psychotic Disorder

Psychotic symptoms—prominently hallucinations or delusions—directly caused by the toxic effects of substance intoxication, substance withdrawal, or medication exposure, persisting beyond typical intoxication.

Substantia Nigra

A group of nerve cells in the middle of the brain involved in movement. Some cells make dopamine and gradually die in Parkinson disease, contributing to stiffness, slowed movement, and tremor.

Substernal Goiter

An enlarged thyroid gland that extends from the neck into the upper chest. It may press on the windpipe or esophagus, causing shortness of breath, cough, or difficulty swallowing. Imaging helps assess its size and position.

Substrate

A substance on which an enzyme acts or a material used by a biochemical pathway.

Subtalar Joint

The joint between the talus and heel bone beneath the ankle. It helps the foot tilt inward and outward.

Subungual Exostosis

A benign osteocartilaginous outgrowth arising beneath the nail, usually of a toe or finger. It causes a painful firm subungual mass and nail deformity and is treated by excision when symptomatic.

Subungual Hematoma

A collection of blood between the nail plate and nail bed, usually after a crush or blunt injury. It may appear red, purple, or black and can cause pressure and throbbing pain. As the nail grows, the discoloration usually moves toward the tip.

Subungual Melanoma

Alternate name; see *Nail Unit Melanoma*.

Subungual Verruca (Wart)

A common wart growing beneath or at the edge of a nail, usually caused by human papillomavirus. It may distort or lift the nail and can be tender. It can resemble other nail growths, including some cancers.

Succenturial Lobe

An accessory lobe of the placenta, connected to the main placenta by blood vessels that traverse the membranes. If undetected after delivery, the succenturial lobe may be retained in the uterus, causing postpartum hemorrhage or infection. Diagnosis: careful inspection of the placenta and membranes after delivery.

Succenturiate Placenta

A succenturiate placenta has one or more accessory lobes separate from the main placenta, which can increase risk of retained tissue or fetal-vessel injury.

Succinate Dehydrogenase

An enzyme inside mitochondria that helps cells make energy. It changes one small molecule into another while passing electrons through the energy-producing system; inherited or tumor-related changes can have clinical importance.

Succinylcholine

A very fast, short-acting medicine that temporarily paralyzes skeletal muscles to help place a breathing tube or perform emergency procedures. It can dangerously raise potassium, stop breathing longer than expected, or trigger malignant hyperthermia in susceptible people.

Succumb

To succumb means to die from or be overcome by a disease, injury, exposure, or other serious process.

Succussion Splash

A splashing sound auscultated over the epigastrium or thorax while gently shaking the patient's torso. In the abdomen, a splash heard more than three to four hours after a meal indicates delayed gastric emptying or gastric outlet obstruction; in the chest, it indicates hydropneumothorax.

Alternate Names:
Hippocratic Succussion Splash

Sucking Blister

A blister or worn area of skin in a newborn, usually on a hand, finger, forearm, or lip, caused by repeated sucking before or during feeding. It is usually harmless and heals on its own.

Sucking Reflex

A primitive reflex present from birth, elicited by placing an object in the infant's mouth. The infant rhythmically sucks on the object. Coordinated sucking and swallowing typically develop by 34-36 weeks gestational age. Premature infants may lack coordinated suck-swallow, requiring gavage feeding.

Sucrose

Common table sugar, a disaccharide made of glucose and fructose. Digestive enzymes split it into these simpler sugars for absorption.

Sucrose Intolerance

Inability to digest or absorb sucrose adequately, often because of congenital or acquired sucrase-isomaltase deficiency. Eating sucrose may cause bloating, cramps, gas, and diarrhea; uncertain diagnosis can lead to unnecessary dietary restriction.

Sucrose Lysis Test

An older blood test once used to look for paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria, a disorder in which red blood cells are unusually vulnerable to destruction. Flow-cytometry testing has largely replaced it because it is more specific and reliable.

Suction

Removal of fluid, secretions, blood, or other material using negative pressure. It may be used in airway care, surgery, wound care, or drainage.

Suction Device

Equipment that creates negative pressure to remove fluid, blood, mucus, or other material. It usually includes a pump, tubing, collection container, and suction catheter or tip and is used in airway care, surgery, or wound drainage.

Suction Tip

The end attachment of a suction device used to remove blood, fluid, secretions, or debris. Common types include the Yankauer tip for oropharyngeal suction and surgical suction tips such as the Frink tip.

Sudden Cardiac Death

Unexpected death caused by a heart problem, often a dangerous heart rhythm or heart attack. It usually happens soon after symptoms begin or without warning.

Alternate Names:
SCD; Massive Fatal Arrhythmia

Sudden Death

Unexpected death occurring rapidly after the onset of symptoms or without recognized warning, often caused by cardiac arrest, dangerous arrhythmia, vascular catastrophe, or another acute condition.

Sudden Infant Death Syndrome

A sudden death of a baby under 1 year old that remains unexplained after a full investigation, including review of the baby's health history, examination of the death scene, and an autopsy (examination of the body after death). It is one kind of sudden unexpected infant death (SUID), a broader term that includes deaths from known or unknown causes.

Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS)

Alternate name; see *Sudden Infant Death Syndrome*.

Alternate Names:
SIDS

Sudden Natural Death Pathology

Postmortem evaluation of an unexpected death from natural disease, commonly involving coronary artery disease, myocardial infarction, cardiomyopathy, myocarditis, pulmonary embolism, epilepsy, or intracranial disease. The cause may remain indeterminate despite complete examination.

Sudden Sensorineural Hearing Loss

A rapid loss of hearing caused by a problem in the inner ear or hearing nerve, often noticed on waking or over a few days. It may be accompanied by ringing or dizziness; recovery is more likely when treatment begins early.

Sudden Unexpected Death in Epilepsy

An unexpected death in a person with epilepsy that is not caused by drowning, injury, prolonged seizure, or another known condition. It is uncommon; controlling seizures, taking prescribed treatment, and discussing nighttime safety may reduce risk.

Sudden Unexpected Death In Infancy

The sudden, unexpected death of an infant that requires investigation of the medical history, circumstances, death scene, and sometimes autopsy. The cause may be identified, or the death may meet the definition of sudden infant death syndrome.

Sudden Unexpected Infant Death

The sudden and unexpected death of an infant younger than 1 year, whether or not the cause is known before investigation. Sudden infant death syndrome is the unexplained subtype after complete scene, history, and autopsy evaluation.

Sudden Visual Loss

Rapid loss or marked reduction of vision in one or both eyes caused by retinal, optic-nerve, vascular, inflammatory, traumatic, or neurologic disease; it may be permanent if the underlying cause is not reversed promptly.

Sudeck Atrophy

An acute post-traumatic or post-surgical manifestation of complex regional pain syndrome type I (CRPS-I) characterized by severe burning neuropathic pain, autonomic vasomotor and sudomotor dysfunction, localized edema, and rapid patchy radiographic osteopenia of the affected limb.

Alternate Names:
Sudeck's Dystrophy; Post-Traumatic Osteoporosis

Sudek's Atrophy

An older name for complex regional pain syndrome with pain, swelling, autonomic change, and regional bone loss.

Sudorifics

Medicines or other treatments that increase sweating. They have limited specific medical uses; excessive sweating caused by a treatment can lead to dehydration, overheating, or abnormal body salts.

Suffocation

Inability to breathe enough because the airway is blocked, oxygen is unavailable, the chest is compressed, or another problem prevents normal breathing. It quickly causes unconsciousness and death without immediate rescue.

Sugammadex

A medicine used during anesthesia to quickly reverse muscle paralysis caused by selected muscle-relaxing medicines. It binds those medicines so the body can remove them; allergic reactions and changes in heart rate are possible.

Sugar Substitutes

Sugar substitutes provide sweetness with little or no sugar; types differ in energy, digestion, aftertaste, and effects on glucose and gastrointestinal symptoms.

Sugar-Water Hemolysis Test

An older laboratory test assessing red-cell resistance to hypotonic sugar solution, historically used in evaluating paroxysmal nocturnal hemoglobinuria and now largely replaced by flow-cytometric testing.

Suicidal Behavior

Actions, preparations, or explicit self-injurious attempts undertaken with the intent to end one's life; see *Suicide And Suicidal Behavior* and *Suicidal Ideation*.

Suicidal Ideation

Thoughts about dying or ending one's life, with or without intent, a plan, or preparatory actions. They may be passive, such as wishing to be dead, or active, involving thoughts of taking one's life. Suicidal ideation is distinct from a suicide attempt.

Suicidal Intent

The degree to which a person expects or wants to die as a result of suicidal thoughts or behavior. It is assessed with the person's own account, planning, preparation, access to means, and other clinical information.

Suicidality

The presence or risk of suicidal thoughts, intent, plans, or behavior. The term describes a clinical domain rather than a diagnosis; risk is influenced by immediacy, access to means, past behavior, and protective factors.

Suicidal Plan

A stated or considered method, timing, place, or other preparation for ending one's own life. A plan, especially with access to means or intent, indicates high and potentially immediate risk.

Suicide

Death caused by an intentional action to end one's life. Suicidal thoughts, plans, or behavior indicate potentially immediate risk and may precede an attempt.

Suicide And Suicidal Behavior

Thoughts, plans, attempts, or acts intended to cause one's own death. Current intent, a plan, access to means, or inability to stay safe indicates immediate risk.

Suicide Attempt

An act in which a person intentionally tries to end their own life but does not die. It can cause serious injury even when the person did not expect to die and is associated with increased risk of later suicide.

Suicide Risk Assessment

A clinical evaluation of suicidal thoughts, intent, plan, access to means, past attempts, self-harm, psychiatric and medical illness, substance use, protective factors, and immediate safety. It informs but does not replace ongoing clinical judgment and safety planning.

Sulcus

A groove or shallow furrow on an organ or body surface, especially the brain or heart. Brain sulci separate raised areas and increase the cerebral cortex's folded surface area.

Sulfa Drugs

A group of medicines, especially sulfonamide antibiotics, that block a chemical pathway bacteria need to grow. They treat selected infections but can cause allergic reactions and other side effects; the term may also refer to nonantibiotic sulfonamides.

Sulfamethoxazole

A sulfonamide antibiotic used commonly with trimethoprim in selected infections.

Sulfasalazine

An anti-inflammatory medicine used for inflammatory bowel disease and rheumatoid or other inflammatory arthritis. It changes immune activity and can cause nausea, rash, low blood counts, liver problems, or kidney problems.

Sulfatide

A fatty substance containing sulfate found mainly in myelin, the insulating covering of nerve fibers. Abnormal buildup or deficiency can disrupt nerve function and occurs in some inherited metabolic disorders.

Sulfite Oxidase Deficiency

A rare inherited metabolic disorder in which sulfite cannot be adequately converted to sulfate. Toxic sulfite and related compounds can cause neonatal seizures, feeding difficulty, abnormal muscle tone, developmental impairment, and progressive brain injury.

Sulfite Sensitivity

Sulfite sensitivity is an adverse reaction to sulfite preservatives, sometimes causing wheeze, flushing, headache, or other symptoms, especially in people with asthma.

Sulfonamide

A synthetic bacteriostatic antimicrobial agent containing a sulfonamide ($-SO_2NH_2$) functional group that acts as a competitive structural analogue of para-aminobenzoic acid (PABA), selectively inhibiting the bacterial enzyme dihydropteroate synthase (DHPS) in the folic acid biosynthetic pathway. Commonly combined with trimethoprim (TMP-SMX, cotrimoxazole) for sequential synergistic inhibition of tetrahydrofolate synthesis, treating urinary tract infections, *Pneumocystis jirovecii* pneumonia, and community-acquired MRSA. Adverse reactions include hypersensitivity rashes, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, hemolytic anemia in G6PD deficiency, and kernicterus in neonates.

Alternate Names:
Sulfonamides; Sulfa Drug; Sulfa Drugs

Sulfonamides

Plural form; see *Sulfonamide*.

Sulfonylurea

A class of oral antidiabetic secretagogues utilized in the management of type 2 diabetes mellitus that stimulate insulin release from pancreatic beta cells. Sulfonylureas bind specifically to the SUR1 subunit of ATP-sensitive potassium (K_{ATP}) channels in the beta-cell membrane, inducing channel closure, membrane depolarization, calcium influx via voltage-gated calcium channels, and exocytosis of preformed insulin granules. Divided into first-generation (e.g., chlorpropamide, tolbutamide) and second-generation agents (glipizide, glyburide, glimepiride); major risks comprise hypoglycemia and weight gain.

Alternate Names:
Sulfonylureas

Sulfonylureas

Plural form; see *Sulfonylurea*.

Sulfur Colloid Scan

A nuclear-medicine scan in which a small radioactive tracer is used to show activity in the liver, spleen, bone marrow, or lymph nodes. It can help assess how these organs work or identify abnormal tissue distribution.

Sulfuric Acid Poisoning

Severe poisoning from sulfuric acid, a highly corrosive chemical. It can cause deep burns of the skin, eyes, mouth, throat, and digestive tract; fumes can injure the airways, and vomiting can cause further tissue damage or aspiration.

Sulindac Overdose

Exposure to an excessive amount of sulindac, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug, may cause nausea, vomiting, stomach bleeding, drowsiness, kidney injury, liver injury, seizures, or metabolic acidosis.

Sulphonamides

A group of medicines, including some antibiotics, that block a chemical pathway bacteria need to grow. They are used for selected infections and other conditions; allergic reactions, interactions, and blood or kidney problems can occur.

Sulphonylureas

Alternate name; see *Sulfonylurea*.

Sumatriptan

A migraine medicine that narrows certain blood vessels and changes nerve signaling to stop acute migraine or cluster headaches.

Summer Diarrhoea

An older term for seasonal diarrheal illness, often referring to infectious diarrhea in children.

Sunburn

An acute inflammatory skin reaction to excessive ultraviolet radiation, usually from sunlight. It causes tender, warm erythema and swelling in exposed areas; more severe injury can blister, followed by peeling as damaged epidermal cells are shed.

Sundowning

Late-day or evening worsening of confusion, agitation, wandering, or behavioral symptoms in some people with dementia or delirium, influenced by fatigue, light, routines, and unmet needs.

Sunflower Syndrome

A rare epilepsy in which a person repeatedly turns toward bright light and waves a hand near the eyes, often triggering absence seizures. It usually begins in childhood and requires neurologic assessment and seizure treatment.

Sunken Chest

Alternate name; see *Pectus Excavatum*.

Sunken Fontanelle

An apparent inward depression of the soft area between an infant's skull bones. It can occur with dehydration or reduced tissue volume but is not specific to either condition. The finding describes an appearance rather than establishing a diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Depressed Fontanelle; Sunken Soft Spot

Sun Protection

Measures that reduce exposure to ultraviolet radiation, including shade, protective clothing, sunglasses, and broad-spectrum sunscreen. They help prevent sunburn, premature skin aging, eye damage, and ultraviolet-related skin cancers.

Alternate Names:
UV Protection; Solar Defense

Sunscreens

Topical products that absorb, scatter, or reflect ultraviolet radiation to reduce sunburn and cumulative ultraviolet skin damage. They may be chemical, mineral, or combined formulations and are commonly described by their broad-spectrum protection and sun-protection factor (SPF).

Sunstroke

A life-threatening form of heat illness in which body temperature rises dangerously high and the nervous system is impaired.

Superantigen

A substance made by some bacteria that activates many immune cells at once. This can cause an excessive release of inflammatory chemicals and contribute to illnesses such as toxic shock syndrome or some forms of scarlet fever.

Superficial

Near the surface of the body or an organ, rather than deep inside it. The term may describe tissues, veins, burns, wounds, or infections that mainly affect the skin and tissue just beneath it.

Superficial Fascia

The soft connective tissue layer just beneath the skin. It contains fat, small blood vessels, nerves, and connective tissue and helps insulate the body and allow the skin to move. In some regions it has distinct named layers, such as Camper and Scarpa fascia in the lower abdomen.

Superficial Siderosis

Hemosiderin deposition along the surface of the brain, spinal cord, or cranial nerves, usually caused by repeated or persistent bleeding into the subarachnoid space. It can damage neural tissue and may cause progressive sensorineural hearing loss, cerebellar ataxia, or myelopathy.

Alternate Names:
Superficial Hemosiderosis of the Central Nervous System; Superficial Siderosis of the CNS

Superficial Spreading Melanoma

The most common cutaneous melanoma subtype, characterized initially by radial growth across the epidermis and an irregularly pigmented patch or plaque before invasion develops.

Superficial Thrombophlebitis

Inflammation and a blood clot in a vein just beneath the skin, causing a tender, firm, red cord. It often improves, but the clot can extend into the deep veins or occur with deep-vein thrombosis.

Superimposed Preeclampsia

Preeclampsia developing in a person who already has chronic hypertension. It may present with new or worsening proteinuria, thrombocytopenia, abnormal liver or kidney tests, neurologic symptoms, or other features of maternal organ dysfunction.

Superinfection

A new infection that develops during or after treatment of a previous infection, often involving an antimicrobial-resistant organism or an organism not susceptible to the original therapy, such as Clostridioides difficile after antibiotic exposure.

Superior

Above or toward the head in the body, or higher than another structure. For example, the neck is superior to the chest. The opposite direction is inferior, meaning below or toward the feet.

Superior Mediastinum

The upper part of the mediastinum, above the level of the sternal angle. It contains the thymus, major blood vessels, trachea, esophagus, nerves, and lymph nodes.

Superior Mesenteric Artery

A major artery branching from the abdominal aorta. It supplies blood to much of the small intestine and to parts of the large intestine, including the right colon and nearby transverse colon.

Superior Mesenteric Artery Syndrome

Pressure on part of the small intestine where it passes between two major arteries, causing blockage. It may follow major weight loss and cause fullness, upper-abdominal pain, nausea, and vomiting; treatment restores nutrition and relieves the obstruction.

Superior Semicircular Canal Dehiscence

A gap or very thin area in the bone covering one balance canal in the inner ear. Loud sounds or pressure may cause dizziness, imbalance, hearing changes, or make a person hear their own voice unusually loudly.

Superior Vena Cava

A large vein in the chest that carries oxygen-poor blood from the head, neck, arms, and upper chest to the right side of the heart.

Superior Vena Caval Obstruction

Narrowing or blockage of the superior vena cava, the large vein that returns blood from the head, neck, arms, and upper chest to the heart. Causes include a chest tumor, a blood clot, or pressure from a nearby structure. It may cause superior vena cava syndrome if blood return is sufficiently impaired.

Alternate Names:
SVCO; Superior Vena Cava Obstruction

Superior Vena Cava Syndrome

A group of symptoms and signs caused by impaired blood flow through the superior vena cava, usually because it is compressed or blocked. It may cause swelling of the face, neck, or arms, visible neck veins, cough, or shortness of breath; severe obstruction can impair breathing or blood flow from the brain.

Supernumerary Digit

An extra finger or toe present from birth, ranging from a small skin tag to a well-formed digit with bone and joints. It may occur alone or with a genetic syndrome and is evaluated for function, circulation,

and associated anomalies.

Supernumerary Nipple

A common congenital anatomical anomaly characterized by the presence of an extra, ectopic nipple occurring along the embryological milk line (mammary ridge) extending bilaterally from the axilla through the normal breast to the groin. Arising from incomplete involution of the embryonic ectodermal mammary ridge, it may range from a subtle pigmented macule (often mistaken for a melanocytic nevus) to a fully developed nipple-areola complex with underlying glandular breast tissue (polymastia).

Alternate Names:
Supernumerary Nipples; Polythelia; Third Nipple

Supernumerary Nipples

Plural form; see *Supernumerary Nipple*.

Supernumerary Rib

An extra rib beyond the typical twelve pairs, most commonly a cervical rib above the first thoracic rib, which may compress the brachial plexus or subclavian vessel causing thoracic outlet syndrome.

Supernumerary Teeth

Teeth that develop in addition to the usual number. They may remain hidden or appear in the mouth and can crowd, displace, or prevent nearby teeth from erupting; a common type develops between the upper front teeth.

Supervised Exercise Therapy

A structured, monitored exercise program used to improve walking ability and reduce claudication symptoms in people with peripheral artery disease. The exercise plan is adjusted to the person's symptoms and functional capacity.

Supination

Rotation of the forearm so that the palm faces anteriorly in anatomical position, or upward when the elbow is flexed. The radius and ulna become parallel.

Supine

Position in which a person lies on the back with the front of the body facing upward. The term describes body orientation, so the person can remain supine on a tilted surface or with the head or upper body raised.

Supine Hypotensive Syndrome

A drop in blood pressure that can occur when a pregnant person lies flat on the back, because the enlarged uterus reduces blood return to the heart. Dizziness, nausea, sweating, or faintness may improve by turning onto the side.

Supine Position

Lying on the back with the face and front of the body upward. It is commonly used for examination, imaging, and surgery, but prolonged use can cause pressure injury and late pregnancy may reduce blood return to the heart.

Supplemental Oxygen Therapy

Administration of oxygen at a concentration above that of room air to treat or prevent clinically important hypoxemia. Delivery method and oxygen target depend on the illness, baseline oxygenation, risk of carbon-dioxide retention, and monitoring results; excessive oxygen can also cause harm.

Supplementation

Use of a vitamin, mineral, protein, fiber, or other nutrient preparation to correct a deficiency or meet a clinically identified increased requirement. Effects and risks depend on the nutrient, dose, interactions, and product quality.

Supplements

Products containing substances such as vitamins, minerals, herbs, or amino acids, taken to add to the diet. They can have side effects, interact with medicines, or vary in product quality.

Supportive Care

Treatment that maintains essential body functions, relieves symptoms, prevents complications, and supports recovery while the underlying cause is treated.

Suppository

A solid preparation inserted into the rectum, vagina, or urethra where it dissolves or melts.

Suppression

Reduction or inhibition of a function, response, symptom, or process.

Suppuration

The formation or discharge of pus, a thick fluid made from immune cells, germs, and damaged tissue. It usually occurs with infection and may form an abscess that needs drainage and treatment.

Suppurative

Producing or containing pus, usually as part of an infection or inflammation.

Suppurative Arthritis

A joint infection producing pus and inflammation, usually caused by bacteria. It can rapidly destroy cartilage and cause fever, severe joint pain, swelling, and limited movement, requiring urgent drainage and antimicrobial treatment.

Supracervical Hysterectomy

Hysterectomy in which the uterine body is removed while the cervix is left in place; the fallopian tubes and ovaries may be removed separately.

Alternate Names:
Subtotal Hysterectomy

Supracondylar Humerus Fracture

A break in the upper part of the elbow end of the arm bone, common in children after a fall on an outstretched hand. Swelling, pain, deformity, or inability to move the elbow may occur; severe fractures can damage nearby nerves or arteries and may require surgery.

Alternate Names:
Gartland Supracondylar Fracture; Pediatric Elbow Fracture

Supraglottic Airway Device

A breathing device placed above the vocal cords to help deliver oxygen and ventilation during anesthesia or emergencies. It can be inserted more quickly than a breathing tube but does not protect against aspiration as reliably.

Supranuclear Ophthalmoplegia

Weakness or loss of control of eye movements caused by damage to brain pathways above the eye-movement nerves. It may make it difficult to look in certain directions.

Supranuclear Palsy

Alternate name; see *Progressive Supranuclear Palsy*.

Suprapubic

Located above the pubic bone in the lower abdomen. The term may describe pain or examination in this area, or a procedure such as inserting a catheter through the lower abdominal wall directly into the bladder when a tube cannot be passed through the urethra.

Suprapubic Catheter

A tube placed through the lower abdominal wall directly into the bladder to drain urine. It may be used when urine cannot drain safely through the urethra or when longer-term bladder drainage is needed.

Suprapubic Catheter Care

Care of a drainage tube that enters the bladder through the lower abdomen, including cleaning the site, keeping the tube unobstructed, securing it, and monitoring urine. Fever, increasing pain, leakage, bleeding, or no urine flow can indicate infection or blockage.

Suprarenal Glands

Two small glands above the kidneys. Their outer layer makes hormones that regulate salt, blood pressure, stress, and metabolism; their inner layer makes adrenaline and related hormones.

Suprascapular Nerve

A nerve from the brachial plexus supplying shoulder

muscles that help lift the arm and rotate it outward.

Suprascapular Neuropathy

Dysfunction of the suprascapular nerve from compression, traction, trauma, or an adjacent lesion. It may cause deep shoulder pain, weakness of abduction or external rotation, and wasting of the supraspinatus or infraspinatus muscles.

Supraspinatus Muscle

One of the four rotator-cuff muscles. It helps lift the arm away from the body and stabilize the shoulder joint; its tendon passes beneath the top of the shoulder and is often injured.

Suprasternal Notch

The shallow dip at the upper border of the manubrium, between the inner ends of the collarbones.

Supraventricular Tachycardia

A fast heart rhythm beginning above the ventricles, often starting and stopping suddenly, causing palpitations, dizziness, or weakness.

Alternate Names:
SVT

Sural Nerve

A sensory nerve formed mainly from branches of the tibial and common fibular nerves. It supplies sensation to the posterolateral lower leg and lateral border of the foot.

Suramin

An antiparasitic medicine used mainly for selected early forms of African trypanosomiasis. It requires specialist use because it can cause serious kidney, nerve, allergic, and other adverse effects.

Surface Anatomy

The study of external body landmarks and visible or palpable structures used to locate deeper anatomical structures and guide physical examination or procedures.

Surfactant

A substance that lowers surface tension. In the lungs, it coats the tiny air sacs and helps keep them open when a person breathes out; premature babies may have too little, contributing to respiratory distress syndrome.

Surgeon

A physician trained to perform operations and invasive procedures, and to evaluate and care for patients before and after surgery.

Surgery

Treatment in which a clinician operates on tissues or organs to diagnose, remove, repair, replace, or improve a body structure. Risks and recovery depend on the procedure and the patient's health.

Surgery For Pancreatic Cancer

An operation to remove a pancreatic tumor and sometimes nearby organs or lymph nodes when the cancer can be safely removed. It is major surgery and may cause bleeding, infection, digestive problems, diabetes, or delayed stomach emptying.

Surgery For Pilonidal Cyst

An operation to drain or remove a recurrent or complicated tunnel or cyst near the cleft of the buttocks. Wound care and keeping the area clean are important; infection, slow healing, and recurrence can occur.

Surgical Abortion

A procedure that removes a pregnancy from the uterus to end a pregnancy or treat an early pregnancy loss. Common methods include vacuum aspiration and dilation and evacuation; the method depends on how far the pregnancy has progressed.

Alternate Names:
Vacuum Aspiration; Suction Curettage; Induced Abortion

Surgical Drain

A tube or device placed during or after surgery to remove blood, pus, bile, urine, or other fluid. The

amount and appearance of drainage are monitored; infection, bleeding, blockage, and tissue injury are possible.

Surgical Drill

A powered instrument used to cut, shape, or make holes in bone during surgery. Friction and heat during use can injure bone or nearby tissues and contribute to infection or bone weakening.

Surgical Excision

Cutting out a lesion, tumor, organ, or other unwanted tissue using an operation. The removed material may be examined under a microscope; bleeding, infection, scarring, damage to nearby structures, and incomplete removal are possible.

Surgical Fixation

Stabilization of a bone, joint, or other structure with devices such as plates, screws, rods, wires, or external frames.

Surgical Forceps

Handheld instruments used during surgery to hold, grasp, move, or manipulate tissue, sutures, dressings, or other materials. Their shape and pressure are selected to limit tissue injury.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Grasping Forceps; Tissue Forceps

Surgical Hemostasis

Control of bleeding during an operation using pressure, ligation, sutures, clips, electrosurgery, topical agents, vessel sealing, or other techniques. Effective hemostasis requires identification of the bleeding source and correction of coagulopathy when present.

Surgical Hemostat

A clamping surgical instrument used to control bleeding by compressing a blood vessel or tissue.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Hemostatic Forceps; Mosquito Clamp

Surgical Instruments

Tools used during operations, including scalpels, scissors, forceps, clamps, retractors, needle holders, and devices controlling bleeding. Each instrument is designed for a specific task and must be cleaned, sterilized, and handled safely.

Surgical Margin

The outer edge of tissue removed during an operation. A laboratory examination checks whether disease reaches that edge: a clear margin suggests no disease was seen there, while an involved margin may mean more treatment is needed.

Surgical Repair

An operation that restores or rebuilds damaged tissue, an organ, or a body function. It may close wounds, reconnect structures, stabilize bones, repair blood vessels, or correct defects present from birth.

Surgical Retractor

A surgical instrument used to hold tissues apart, giving doctors a clearer and safer view of the operating area.

Alternate Names:
Tissue Retractor; Wound Retractor

Surgical Risk Stratification

Estimation of the likelihood of perioperative complications using patient factors, urgency, procedure risk, functional capacity, and disease-specific assessment. It informs optimization, monitoring level, shared decisions, and postoperative planning but cannot eliminate uncertainty.

Surgical Safety Checklist

A structured checklist used at defined points before anesthesia, before incision, and before leaving the operating room to verify patient identity, procedure, site, consent, equipment, specimens, and team communication.

Surgical Scissors

Surgical instruments designed to cut tissue, sutures, dressings, or other materials. Different shapes and blade types are selected for delicate, deep, curved, or heavy-duty work.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Scissors; Operating Shears

Surgical Tracheostomy

The operative creation of an opening in the anterior neck into the trachea to secure an airway; see *Tracheostomy*.

Surgical Site Infection

Infection involving the incision, organ, or operative space within the surveillance period after surgery. It may be superficial incisional, deep incisional, or organ-space and requires appropriate culture, antimicrobial therapy, drainage, debridement, or reoperation when indicated.

Surgical Stapler

A device that places metal or absorbable staples to close skin, join tissue, or seal a hollow organ during an operation. Incorrect placement can cause bleeding, leakage, narrowing, or injury.

Surgical Time-Out

A deliberate team pause immediately before incision to verify patient identity, procedure, site, consent, allergies, antibiotics, imaging, implants, equipment, and anticipated critical events. It is a core surgical-safety intervention.

Surgical Wound Classification

Categorization of an operative wound as clean, clean-contaminated, contaminated, or dirty/infected according to the degree of microbial exposure and existing infection. The class helps estimate surgical-site infection risk and guide prophylaxis.

Surgical Wound Infection Treatment

Management of infection in or around a surgical wound, including assessment of depth and severity, drainage or debridement when needed, wound care, and targeted antimicrobial therapy when indicated.

Surrogacy

Surrogacy is an arrangement in which a person carries a pregnancy for intended parent or parents; medical, legal, ethical, and psychosocial requirements vary by jurisdiction.

Surrogate

A substitute or proxy. In medical research, a surrogate outcome is a measurable change, such as a blood-test result, used to estimate a patient-important outcome such as fewer symptoms or longer survival.

Surrogate Decision-Maker

A person authorized to make healthcare decisions for someone who lacks decision-making capacity, guided by the person's known values and preferences.

Surveillance

The planned collection and review of health information to detect changes in disease, follow a known condition, or identify problems early. It may involve routine reports, active case finding, selected monitoring sites, or regular follow-up of an individual.

Surveillance Imaging

Planned repeat imaging used to monitor disease, treatment response, or possible recurrence. The timing and type of scan depend on the condition, previous treatment, symptoms, risks, and expected usefulness of results.

Survival Rate

The percentage of people alive after a specified time from diagnosis or treatment, commonly measured at five years.

Survivorship

The period of living during and after cancer treatment, together with the care provided during that time. It may include checking for return of cancer, treating late effects, supporting emotional health, improving quality of life, and managing other illnesses.

Survivorship Care Plan

A written summary of cancer treatment, recommended follow-up, possible late effects, screening,

medicines, and contacts for ongoing care. It helps the person and healthcare team coordinate care after treatment.

Susac Syndrome

A rare disease in which inflammation and blockage of tiny blood vessels can affect the brain, eyes, and inner ears. It may cause confusion or headache, vision loss, and hearing loss; all features may not appear at once.

Susceptibility

The likelihood of being affected by a disease, exposure, medicine, or microorganism. Susceptibility can reflect genetics, age, immunity, health conditions, previous exposure, dose, or the organism's drug resistance.

Susceptibility Testing

Laboratory testing that shows which antibiotics are likely to stop a person's bacterial infection. The result helps clinicians choose treatment, especially when resistance is possible.

Susceptibility-Weighted Imaging

An MRI technique that is especially sensitive to small veins, blood products, iron, and some calcium deposits in tissue, particularly in the brain.

Suspected Cause

A condition, exposure, or factor believed to explain a symptom or disease but not yet proven. Further history, examination, testing, or observation may support or reject the suspected cause.

Suspension

A liquid medicine in which fine drug particles are spread through the liquid rather than dissolved. The container may need shaking so each dose contains the intended amount; settling, inaccurate measuring, and contamination can cause problems.

Sustained Virologic Response

No detectable hepatitis C virus in the blood 12 or more weeks after antiviral treatment. This is considered a cure of that infection, but it does not protect against catching hepatitis C again.

Suture

A stitch or material used to close or join tissue.

Suture Anchor

A small implant that secures a tendon, ligament, or other soft tissue to bone. It may be made from metal, polymer, or bioabsorbable material and can fail through pullout, breakage, migration, or inflammatory reaction.

SUV

Standardized uptake value, a number estimating how much radioactive tracer is concentrated in tissue during a PET scan. Clinicians compare it with surrounding tissue and clinical findings to assess tumors or inflammation.

SVC Obstruction

Blockage or compression of the superior vena cava, the large vein returning blood from the head, neck, arms, and upper chest to the heart. It may cause facial or arm swelling, prominent neck veins, cough, headache, or breathing difficulty.

SVC Syndrome

Blockage or compression of the superior vena cava, the large vein returning blood from the upper body to the heart. It may cause swelling of the face, neck, or arms, visible neck veins, cough, or breathing difficulty.

SVT

Alternate name; see *Supraventricular Tachycardia*.

Swab

A small absorbent stick used to collect a sample from the skin, throat, nose, wound, or another body site. The sample can be tested for infection or other conditions, and correct collection affects the result.

Swallowing

The movement of food, liquid, or saliva from the

mouth through the throat and esophagus into the stomach. Problems may cause coughing, choking, food sticking, or material entering the airway.

Alternate Names:
Deglutition; Ingestion

Swallowing Assessment

An evaluation of how safely and effectively a person moves food, liquid, or saliva from the mouth to the stomach. It may include observation, X-ray or camera testing, and recommendations about exercises, posture, or food and drink textures.

Swallowing Chalk

Ingestion of chalk, which is usually low in toxicity in small amounts but can cause choking, constipation, or gastrointestinal upset; repeated eating may indicate pica.

Swallowing Difficulty

Dysphagia, or impaired movement of food or liquid from the mouth to the stomach, caused by oropharyngeal, esophageal, neuromuscular, structural, or functional disorders.

Swallowing Problems

Difficulty moving food, liquid, or saliva safely from the mouth to the stomach; dysphagia can cause choking, aspiration, weight loss, or dehydration.

Swallowing Soap

Ingestion of soap, which commonly causes mouth or stomach irritation, nausea, or diarrhea; concentrated or large exposures can injure tissue or affect breathing.

Swallowing Sunscreen

Ingestion of sunscreen, usually causing mild gastrointestinal upset but potentially causing choking or aspiration depending on the amount and product; breathing difficulty or persistent vomiting can signal serious exposure.

Swallowing Syncope

Fainting triggered by swallowing, usually through an abnormal reflex that slows the heart or lowers blood pressure; it can be associated with heart-rhythm or structural heart disease.

Swallowing Therapy

Assessment and treatment to make swallowing safer and more effective. A speech-language therapist may teach exercises, positioning, food-texture changes, and strategies to reduce aspiration into the airway.

Swallow Study

An X-ray test that records a person swallowing food or liquid mixed with barium. It shows how the mouth and throat work, whether material enters the airway, and whether changes could make swallowing safer.

Swan-Ganz Catheter

A thin tube passed through the right side of the heart into a lung artery to measure pressures and estimate how much blood the heart pumps. It is used selectively in seriously ill patients because complications are possible.

Swan-Ganz Catheterization

A procedure in which a thin catheter is passed through the right side of the heart into a lung artery to measure heart pressures and blood flow. It is used selectively in critically ill patients because bleeding, infection, rhythm problems, or vessel injury can occur.

Swan Neck Deformity

A characteristic joint deformity of the hand in which there is hyperextension of the proximal interphalangeal (PIP) joint accompanied by compensatory flexion of the distal interphalangeal (DIP) joint. It is classically seen in advanced rheumatoid arthritis, systemic lupus erythematosus, and chronic tendon imbalance.

Swan-Neck Deformity

A finger shape problem where the middle joint bends backward and the fingertip curls down, commonly caused by rheumatoid arthritis.

Sweat

Fluid produced by sweat glands, mainly to cool the body as it evaporates. Sweating can also increase with exercise, fever, stress, hormones, or some medicines.

Sweat Chloride Test

A test that measures salt levels in sweat to help diagnose cystic fibrosis. A high result supports the diagnosis, but it is interpreted with symptoms and may be repeated or followed by genetic testing because other factors can affect results.

Sweat Electrolytes Test

A sweat electrolytes test measures salts, especially chloride, in sweat and is commonly used to help diagnose cystic fibrosis.

Sweat Gland

A microscopic tubular exocrine skin gland that secretes sweat for thermoregulation and excretion, categorized into eccrine and apocrine glands. Eccrine sweat glands are distributed widely across the entire skin surface (highest density on the palms, soles, and forehead) and secrete a hypotonic watery electrolyte solution directly onto the epidermal surface under sympathetic cholinergic control to facilitate evaporative cooling. Apocrine sweat glands are restricted to axillary, perineal, and areolar regions, opening into hair follicles to secrete a viscous, lipid- and protein-rich fluid under adrenergic control that undergoes bacterial decomposition to produce characteristic body odor.

Alternate Names:
Sweat Glands; Sudoriferous Gland

Sweat Glands

Plural form; see *Sweat Gland*.

Sweat Gland Tumor

A growth arising from cells of a sweat gland. Most are benign skin lumps, but some are cancerous and may grow, ulcerate, bleed, or spread. Examination and biopsy determine the type; complete removal is often used, with wider treatment and follow-up for cancerous tumors.

Sweating

Production of sweat by eccrine and apocrine glands for heat regulation and other responses; excessive, absent, or asymmetric sweating can indicate medication, autonomic, endocrine, or neurologic disease.

Sweating And Body Odor

Excess perspiration or noticeable odor produced when skin bacteria break down sweat; it may be influenced by hygiene, diet, medicines, hormones, or disease.

Alternate Names:
Diaphoresis and Bromhidrosis; Perspiration and Osmidrosis

Sweetened Beverages

Sweetened beverages contain added sugars and can increase calorie intake, dental caries, obesity, and diabetes risk when consumed frequently.

Sweet's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Acute Febrile Neutrophilic Dermatosis*.

Sweet Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Acute Febrile Neutrophilic Dermatosis*.

Swelling

Abnormal enlargement caused by fluid accumulation, inflammation, bleeding, infection, tumor, or tissue injury; location, onset, pain, and associated symptoms identify the likely cause.

Swimmer's Ear

Swimmer's ear, also called otitis externa, is inflammation or infection of the skin lining the outer ear canal. It often develops when moisture remains in the canal, allowing bacteria or fungi to grow. Scratching, cotton swabs, or other irritation can also damage the canal's protective skin. Symptoms include ear pain, itching, redness, swelling, drainage, and pain when the outer ear is touched.

Alternate Names:
Otitis Externa; Tropical Ear

Swimmer's Itch

An itchy rash caused by an allergic reaction to microscopic parasites released by infected snails in freshwater or saltwater.

Alternate Names:
Cercarial Dermatitis; Schistosome Dermatitis; Bather's Itch

Swimming Pool Granuloma

A slowly developing skin infection caused by a water-dwelling bacterium after exposure to an aquarium, swimming pool, or natural water. It can cause persistent bumps or sores, often spreading along the arm or hand, and needs specific antibiotic treatment.

Swine Flu

Alternate informal term; see *Influenza A Virus*.

Swollen Ankles And Swollen Feet

Enlargement of the ankles or feet caused by injury, venous insufficiency, lymphatic disease, medication, pregnancy, or systemic fluid retention from heart, kidney, or liver disease. Sudden one-sided swelling with pain, redness, warmth, or breathlessness may indicate thrombosis or infection.

Alternate Names:
Peripheral Dependent Edema; Pedal Edema

Swollen Glands

Lymph nodes that are larger than usual, often because the immune system is responding to infection or inflammation. They may be tender; hard, fixed, enlarging, or unexplained nodes can have causes other than infection.

Alternate Names:
Lymphadenomegaly; Adenopathy

Swollen Gums

Pathologic enlargement, edema, or hypertrophy of the gingival tissue. Etiologies include plaque-induced gingivitis, periodontal disease, acute oral infections, hormonal fluctuations during pregnancy, nutritional deficiencies (such as scurvy), leukemia, or drug-induced gingival hyperplasia from medications like calcium channel blockers, phenytoin, and cyclosporine.

Alternate Names:
Gingival Swelling Gingival Hyperplasia Gingival Enlargement Enlarged Gums

Swollen Legs

Alternate name; see *Leg Swelling*.

Swollen Lymph Glands

Enlarged lymph nodes, usually caused by infection or inflammation and less often by cancer. They commonly occur in the neck, armpits, or groin; persistent, hard, fixed, or unexplained swelling may have a serious cause.

Alternate Names:
Lymphadenopathy; Lymph Node Enlargement

Swollen Lymph Nodes

Enlarged immune glands, commonly from infection but sometimes from inflammation, medication, or cancer; persistent, hard, or generalized nodes may reflect a more serious cause.

Alternate Names:
Lymphadenopathy; Adenopathy; Bubo

Swollen Lymph Nodes Entry

Alternate name; see *Swollen Lymph Nodes*.

Swollen Tongue

Enlargement of the tongue caused by injury, infection, allergy, inflammation, bleeding, or another condition; sudden breathing difficulty is an emergency.

Swyer Syndrome

A form of pure 46,XY gonadal dysgenesis resulting from mutations in the *SRY* gene or related sex-determining pathways, presenting as a phenotypic female with normal external female genitalia, streak gonads, absent puberty, and primary amenorrhea, carrying a high risk of gonadoblastoma in the streak gonads.

Alternate Names:
46,XY Pure Gonadal Dysgenesis

Sycosis Barbae

Long-lasting inflammation or infection of hair follicles in the beard area, usually involving bacteria and ingrown hairs. It can cause painful bumps, pus, crusting, scarring, and hair loss and needs appropriate treatment.

Sydenham Chorea

A delayed neurologic complication of group A streptococcal infection causing involuntary jerky movements, hypotonia, emotional lability, and coordination problems, usually in children.

Sydenham's Chorea

A delayed immune complication of group A streptococcal infection, usually in children. It causes involuntary, irregular movements and may cause clumsiness, muscle weakness, emotional changes, or difficulty with speech and daily tasks.

Symblepharon

Scar tissue that joins the inside of the eyelid to the eye's surface, usually after a severe burn, inflammation, or eye disease. It can restrict eye movement, cause dryness or pain, and may need specialist treatment.

Symmastia

An abnormal connection or loss of the normal separation between the breasts across the midline of the chest, sometimes occurring after breast surgery or reconstruction. Management depends on symptoms, anatomy, and cause.

Sympathectomy

Surgical interruption or destruction of sympathetic nerves to reduce abnormal vasoconstriction, sweating, or pain in selected conditions.

Sympathetic

Relating to the part of the autonomic nervous system that prepares the body for activity or stress by changing heart rate, blood-vessel tone, sweating, breathing, and digestion. In everyday language, it can also mean showing concern for another person.

Sympathetic Ganglion

A small group of nerve cells outside the brain and spinal cord that relays automatic signals to blood vessels, sweat glands, and internal organs. These signals help control heart rate, blood pressure, digestion, and body responses to stress.

Sympathetic Nervous System

The autonomic division that prepares the body for activity or stress by increasing heart rate and altering vascular, airway, and digestive function.

Sympatholytic

A medicine or treatment that reduces adrenaline-like nerve activity. It may lower blood pressure, slow the heart, or reduce excessive sweating, but the effects and risks depend on the specific medicine and require appropriate prescribing.

Sympathomimetic Drugs

Medicines that imitate the body's adrenaline-like nerve activity, often by stimulating alpha or beta receptors. They may open airways, raise blood pressure, or reduce congestion but can cause fast heartbeat, anxiety, or dangerous effects.

Sympathomimetic Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Sympathomimetic Toxidrome*.

Sympathomimetic Toxicity

Excess catecholamine activity causing agitation, mydriasis, diaphoresis, tachycardia, hypertension, hyperthermia, chest pain, seizures, stroke, or rhabdomyolysis. Unlike anticholinergic toxicity, sweating is usually prominent; benzodiazepines, active cooling, ECG monitoring, and treatment of ischemia, hypertension, and complications are central.

Sympathomimetic Toxidrome

A poisoning pattern caused by excessive adrenergic stimulation, producing agitation, sweating, dilated pupils, rapid heart rate, high blood pressure, elevated temperature, tremor, or seizures.

Symphysis

A joint where two bones are joined by a pad of tough cartilage. The pubic symphysis connects the front pelvic bones and normally allows slight movement, especially during pregnancy and childbirth.

Symphysis-Fundal Height

The distance from the top of the pubic bone to the top of the uterus, measured through the abdomen during pregnancy. From about 24 to 36 weeks, the measurement often roughly matches the number of weeks of pregnancy. A larger or smaller result may lead to an ultrasound to check fetal growth, fluid, or the pregnancy dates.

Alternate Names:
Fundal Height Measurement; SFH

Symphysis Pubis

The fibrocartilaginous joint connecting the left and right pubic bones at the front of the pelvis.

Symptom

A change or problem felt or reported by a patient that may suggest illness, such as pain, nausea, or breathlessness.

Symptomatic

Having symptoms caused by a disease or condition; symptomatic treatment relieves those symptoms without necessarily treating the underlying cause.

Symptomatic Disease

A stage or presentation of an illness in which an individual experiences recognizable physical or mental symptoms, such as pain, fever, cough, fatigue, or nausea. It contrasts with asymptomatic or subclinical disease, in which pathological changes or infections exist without causing noticeable symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Clinical Disease; Manifest Disease; Overt Disease

Symptomatic Porphyria

Porphyria causing clinical attacks or ongoing symptoms from abnormal heme production. Manifestations may include severe abdominal pain, neurologic or psychiatric symptoms, blistering or sun-sensitive skin, or liver complications depending on the type.

Symptomatic Treatment

Care aimed at relieving symptoms such as pain, fever, nausea, itching, or cough without directly removing the underlying cause. It may be used alone or alongside treatment for the disease itself.

Synaesthesia

Synaesthesia is a neurological trait in which stimulation of one sense or mental process automatically produces an additional sensory experience, such as seeing colors when hearing sounds.

Synapse

A connection where one nerve cell communicates with another nerve cell, muscle, or gland. Signals cross the small gap using chemicals or electrical changes to control movement, sensation, thought, and body functions.

Synapse Assembly

The developmental process by which neurons form organized connections with other neurons or target cells, using cell-adhesion molecules and signaling proteins.

Synapsins

A family of neuronal proteins that help organize synaptic vesicles and regulate the release of neurotransmitters.

Synaptic Cleft

The very small gap between a presynaptic neuron and its target cell across which neurotransmitters travel.

Synaptic Membrane

The specialized membrane at a neuronal junction, including the neurotransmitter-releasing presynaptic membrane and receptor-containing postsynaptic membrane.

Synaptic Plasticity

The ability of connections between nerve cells to become stronger, weaker, or structurally different in response to activity. It supports learning, memory, adaptation, and some changes in chronic pain.

Synaptic Transmission

Communication between nerve cells or between a nerve cell and another target across a synapse. Electrical signals trigger release of chemical messengers, which bind receptors and change the receiving cell's activity.

Synaptic Vesicle

A small membrane-bound sac in a nerve ending that stores neurotransmitters and releases them into the synaptic cleft when the neuron is activated.

Synaptonemal Complex

A temporary protein structure that pairs matching chromosomes during egg or sperm formation. It helps chromosomes exchange genetic material accurately before cells divide and is important for normal reproductive development.

Synaptosome

A sealed nerve-terminal structure produced when brain tissue is mechanically disrupted; it is used to study neurotransmitter release and synaptic function.

Synaptotagmin

A calcium-sensing protein on nerve-cell storage sacs that helps trigger rapid release of chemical nerve signals. It is essential for communication between nerve cells and between nerves and muscles.

Synarthrosis

A joint with little or no movement, such as a skull suture or tooth anchored in its socket, in which bones are joined by fibrous tissue or cartilage.

Synchondroses

Cartilage-based joints in which bones are joined by hyaline cartilage and allow little or no movement. Growth plates and the joint between the first rib and the breastbone are examples.

Synchronized Cardioversion

Delivery of an electrical shock timed with the heart's electrical cycle to restore a more organized rhythm. It treats selected fast rhythms; sedation, clot prevention, monitoring, and energy settings depend on the rhythm and patient.

Alternate Names:
Direct Current Cardioversion; Electrical Cardioversion; R-Wave Synchronized Shock

Syncope

A brief loss of consciousness and muscle control caused by a temporary reduction in blood flow to the brain, followed by spontaneous recovery. Common causes include reflex fainting, a sudden blood-pressure drop, dehydration, and heart disease; prolonged confusion may suggest another cause.

Alternate Names:
Passing Out; Temporary Loss of Consciousness; Swoon

Syndactyly

Congenital joining or webbing of two or more fingers or toes. It may occur alone or with a genetic syndrome and sometimes requires reconstructive surgery.

Syndecan

A group of proteins on the cell surface that help cells attach to their surroundings and receive signals. They contribute to tissue development, healing, and responses to injury.

Syndesmophyte

A thin, bony growth that forms along the edges of the vertebrae, often in ankylosing spondylitis, and may bridge adjacent vertebrae.

Syndesmoses

Fibrous joints in which two bones are held together by strong ligaments or a sheet of connective tissue. They allow little movement; the joint between the

lower leg bones near the ankle is one example.

Syndrome

A group of symptoms, signs, or test findings that commonly occur together. A syndrome may have several possible causes and does not always name one specific disease.

Syndrome Of Inappropriate ADH Secretion

Excessive antidiuretic hormone activity causing water retention and low blood sodium despite no major swelling or dehydration. It may result from lung disease, medicines, cancer, or brain disorders and can cause confusion or seizures.

Syndrome of Inappropriate Antidiuresis (SIAD)

Excessive vasopressin activity causes retention of free water, inappropriately concentrated urine, and usually low serum sodium despite no appropriate physiologic stimulus. Causes include medicines, lung or brain disease, cancer, and postoperative stress; severe hyponatremia can cause seizures or coma.

Syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone

Excessive release or effect of antidiuretic hormone causing impaired free-water excretion, low serum sodium, and inappropriately concentrated urine in the absence of an appropriate physiologic stimulus.

Syndrome Of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion

Excessive activity of the water-retaining hormone vasopressin causes the body to retain water and lowers the blood sodium level. Causes include medicines, lung disease, cancer, and brain disorders; severe cases can cause confusion or seizures.

Alternate Names:
SIADH; Schwartz-Bartter Syndrome

Syndrome X

Alternate name; see *Metabolic Syndrome*.

Synechia

An abnormal band of scar-like tissue joining surfaces that should remain separate. In the eye, it may attach the iris to the lens or cornea and interfere with fluid drainage or vision.

Synechiae

Abnormal bands of scar-like tissue joining surfaces that should remain separate. They may occur in the eye, uterus, nose, or other sites and can restrict movement, block passages, or impair function.

Synergist

A muscle, drug, or factor that works together with another to produce or enhance an effect.

Synergistic Necrotizing Fasciitis

A rapidly progressive necrotizing soft-tissue infection caused by mixed aerobic and anaerobic organisms acting together. Severe pain, swelling, skin discoloration, fever, and systemic toxicity may occur; the infection can rapidly cause sepsis and death.

Synesthesia

Synesthesia is a stable perceptual phenomenon in which stimulation of one sensory pathway automatically produces an experience in another, such as seeing colors with sounds.

Synostoses

Fusions between two bones in which bone tissue joins them together. They may be present from birth or develop later and can limit growth or movement depending on their location.

Synostosis

Fusion of two bones by bone tissue, present from birth or developing later. It may be harmless, but fusion in the skull, forearm, or other important area can restrict growth or movement.

Synovectomy

An operation to remove part or all of an inflamed lining inside a joint. It may reduce pain and swelling in selected cases of arthritis or repeated joint in-

flammation and can be done through small cuts or open surgery.

Synovial Biopsy

A synovial biopsy removes a small sample of the joint lining to investigate infection, inflammatory arthritis, crystal disease, or an unusual joint lesion.

Synovial Bursa

A small, fluid-filled sac near a joint that reduces rubbing between moving tissues such as tendons, muscles, skin, and bone. Irritation or inflammation of a bursa causes bursitis, pain, and swelling.

Synovial Chondromatosis

A usually noncancerous condition in which the joint lining forms many small cartilage nodules that may break loose. It can cause pain, swelling, catching, and limited movement, often in the knee, hip, or elbow.

Synovial Cyst

A fluid-filled sac near a joint or tendon sheath, sometimes connected to the joint and sometimes containing material similar to that in a ganglion cyst. It may press on nearby nerves and cause pain, numbness, or weakness.

Synovial Fluid

A slippery fluid inside a freely movable joint that reduces friction and helps nourish cartilage. Changes in its amount or contents can occur with injury, infection, bleeding, crystals, or arthritis.

Alternate Names:
Synovia

Synovial Fluid Analysis

Testing fluid removed from a swollen or painful joint. The laboratory examines its appearance, cells, crystals, and germs to help distinguish injury, arthritis, gout, bleeding, and joint infection; a very hot, painful joint can indicate infection.

Synovial Joint

The most common and freely movable (diarthrodial) classification of joint in the human body, characterized by a fluid-filled joint cavity enclosed by an outer fibrous joint capsule and an inner vascular synovial membrane. Opposing articular bone surfaces are lined by smooth, avascular hyaline articular cartilage that minimizes friction and absorbs compressive shock. The synovial membrane secretes viscous synovial fluid (rich in hyaluronic acid and lubricin) that nourishes articular chondrocytes and lubricates joint movement.

Alternate Names:
Synovial Joints; Diarthrosis

Synovial Joints

Plural form; see *Synovial Joint*.

Synovial Membrane

The thin lining inside a freely moving joint. It makes synovial fluid, which reduces rubbing and helps nourish the smooth joint surfaces; inflammation of this lining causes swelling and pain.

Synovial Reaction To Implanted Prostheses

Inflammation or tissue change around an artificial joint caused by wear particles, loosening, corrosion, infection, or an immune reaction. It may cause pain, swelling, or reduced function after joint replacement.

Synovial Sarcoma

A cancer of soft tissue that often develops near a joint in an arm or leg, especially in adolescents and young adults. Diagnosis requires tissue testing; treatment may include surgery, radiation, or chemotherapy.

Synoviocytes

Synoviocytes are cells lining the joint synovium that produce lubricating fluid and inflammatory mediators and help maintain or damage joint tissue.

Synovitis

Inflammation of the lining inside a joint, causing swelling, warmth, pain, or reduced movement. It may follow injury or occur with arthritis, gout, autoimmune disease, or infection; a hot, very painful

joint can indicate infection.

Synovium

Tissue lining a joint or tendon sheath that makes lubricating fluid and helps support smooth movement.

Synovography

An imaging test in which contrast is placed inside a joint to outline its capsule, lining, or possible tear. It is used selectively; MRI, ultrasound, or other scans are often preferred for joint problems.

Synthetic Androgen

A synthetic androgen is a manufactured compound that activates androgen receptors and may mimic testosterone; therapeutic and anabolic use can suppress gonadal function and cause acne, mood effects, infertility, liver injury, or cardiovascular harm.

Synthetic Biology

Synthetic biology combines biology and engineering to design or modify biological systems. It has potential medical uses but also requires careful safety and ethical oversight.

Syphilis

A sexually transmitted infection caused by Treponema pallidum that progresses through primary, secondary, latent, and tertiary stages and can affect the nervous system, eyes, heart, or fetus.

Syphilis Serology

Blood tests used to screen for syphilis and monitor response to treatment. A reactive result usually needs confirmation with a different test and interpretation alongside symptoms, examination, and treatment history.

Syphilitic Alopecia

Non-scarring hair loss occurring as a manifestation of secondary syphilis, presenting with diffuse thinning or patchy, moth-eaten alopecia of the scalp, eyebrows, or beard. It is thought to result from direct spirochaetal invasion of hair follicles during the spirochaetaemic phase.

Syphilitic Aseptic Meningitis

Syphilitic aseptic meningitis is inflammation of the meninges caused by Treponema pallidum, producing headache, neck stiffness, cranial-nerve symptoms, or other neurologic findings.

Syphilitic Gumma

A destructive lump or area of inflammation caused by long-standing untreated syphilis. It can affect the skin, bones, liver, brain, or other organs and may form a firm mass or ulcer; appropriate antibiotic treatment can prevent further damage.

Syringe

A medical device with a hollow barrel, movable plunger, and tip that may connect to a needle, catheter, or other fitting. It is used to draw up, measure, inject, or remove fluids. Common types include disposable, oral, insulin, tuberculin, and safety syringes.

Alternate Names:
Medical Syringe

Syringe Drivers

Small pumps that push medicine from a syringe continuously or at programmed times. They provide controlled delivery when precise dosing is needed, including pain relief, symptom control, or medicines given under the skin.

Syringocystadenoma Papilliferum

A usually harmless sweat-gland skin growth, often appearing as a small bump or plaque on the scalp or face. It may develop within a birthmark and can resemble other lesions, so diagnosis may require examination or biopsy.

Syringoma

A syringoma is a benign tumor of sweat-duct cells, usually appearing as small skin-colored or yellowish papules around the eyelids or elsewhere.

Syringomyelia

A fluid-filled cavity that develops inside the spinal cord. It can slowly damage the cord and cause pain, weakness, loss of pain or temperature sensation, stiffness, or problems with bladder, bowel, or sexual function.

Syrinx

A fluid-filled cavity within the spinal cord, usually related to disturbed movement of the fluid around the brain and spinal cord. It can damage nerve tissue and cause pain, weakness, stiffness, or loss of sensation; a syrinx in the cord is called syringomyelia.

Syrup

A syrup is a viscous liquid preparation, often sweetened, used as a medicine vehicle or oral dosage form; concentration and ingredients determine safe dosing.

Systematic Desensitization

A behavioral therapy technique that pairs gradual, planned exposure to a feared situation with relaxation or other coping skills. It is used mainly for phobias and anxiety and is adapted to the person's response.

Systemic

Affecting the whole body or relating to an entire system rather than a localized site.

Systemic Aleukemic Reticuloendotheliosis

A historical name for a leukemic reticuloendothelial disorder, most often referring to the aleukemic form of hairy-cell leukemia. It may cause low blood counts, an enlarged spleen, infections, fatigue, or bleeding and is diagnosed by blood, marrow, and immunophenotypic studies.

Systemic Anatomy

The study of the structures of the body organized by organ system, such as the skeletal, muscular, nervous, cardiovascular, or digestive system.

Systemic Antifungals

Antifungal medicines taken orally or given intravenously for infections that are extensive, invasive, refractory, or unsuitable for topical treatment. Choice and duration depend on the organism, site, severity, drug interactions, organ function, and local resistance patterns.

Systemic Chemotherapy

Systemic chemotherapy uses medicines that travel through the bloodstream to kill or slow cancer cells throughout the body.

Systemic Circuit

The circulation that carries oxygenated blood from the left ventricle through the body and returns deoxygenated blood to the right atrium.

Systemic Dermatoses

Skin manifestations that arise as secondary signs of internal medical diseases, such as endocrine disorders, autoimmune conditions, internal malignancies, or nutritional deficiencies.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Manifestations of Systemic Disease; Systemic Skin Signs

Systemic Disease

A disease that affects the whole body or several organs rather than one local area. Examples include autoimmune disease, widespread infection, hormonal disorders, and some cancers.

Systemic Effects

Effects involving the whole body rather than one local area. A medicine, infection, toxin, or disease may produce systemic cardiac, neurologic, kidney, liver, blood, or other effects.

Systemic Exertional Intolerance Disease

Alternate name; see *Myalgic Encephalomyelitis/Chronic Fatigue Syndrome*.

Systemic Inflammatory Response Syndrome

A body-wide inflammatory response to infection or noninfectious problems such as injury, burns, pan-

creatitis, or surgery. The classic adult definition requires at least two of four findings: temperature >38°C or <36°C; heart rate >90 beats/min; breathing rate >20/min or arterial $PaCO_2$ <32 mmHg (4.3 kPa); or white blood-cell count $> 12 \times 10^9$/L or $< 4 \times 10^9$/L, or >10% immature neutrophils. SIRS can occur without infection and is not the same as sepsis.

Systemic Juvenile Idiopathic Arthritis

A childhood inflammatory disease causing repeated high fevers, a temporary pink rash, and swollen or painful joints. It can also enlarge lymph nodes, liver, or spleen and may affect other organs, requiring specialist monitoring and treatment.

Systemic Lupus

Systemic lupus erythematosus is an autoimmune disease that can affect skin, joints, kidneys, blood, nervous system, lungs, and heart. Symptoms fluctuate, and treatment is tailored to organ involvement with sun protection, monitoring, and immunomodulatory medicines.

Alternate Names:
Systemic Lupus Erythematosus; SLE

Systemic Lupus Erythematosus

A chronic autoimmune disease in which the immune system mistakenly attacks healthy tissues and organs throughout the body, triggering widespread inflammation. Because it can affect almost any body system, symptoms vary widely from person to person and often come in unpredictable flares followed by periods of remission. Common signs include extreme fatigue, joint pain and swelling, low-grade fevers, sun sensitivity, and a characteristic butterfly-shaped rash across the cheeks and bridge of the nose, with potential complications involving the kidneys, heart, lungs, and brain.

Alternate Names:
SLE; Lupus; Lupus Erythematosus

Systemic Lupus Erythematosus (SLE) and Pregnancy

SLE can affect fertility, kidneys, blood counts, blood vessels, placenta, and fetal growth, while pregnancy can trigger disease activity. Preconception planning, compatible medicines, antibody testing, blood-pressure and kidney monitoring, and maternal-fetal surveillance are important.

Systemic Mastocytosis

A rare disorder in which abnormal mast cells build up in the bone marrow or other organs. When activated, these immune cells release chemicals that can cause flushing, itching, abdominal cramps, faintness, or severe allergic reactions. In some forms, mast-cell buildup can damage organs.

Systemic Scleroderma

Alternate name; see *Systemic Sclerosis*.

Systemic Sclerosis

A chronic autoimmune connective-tissue disease marked by small-vessel abnormalities and excess collagen deposition (fibrosis) in the skin or internal organs. Skin thickening and Raynaud phenomenon are characteristic; the digestive tract, lungs, heart, and kidneys may also be affected.

Systemic Sclerosis-Associated Arthritis

Joint pain or inflammation occurring in systemic sclerosis. Stiffness, swelling, or reduced movement may occur, and symptoms can overlap with other connective-tissue diseases.

Systemic Therapy

Treatment that travels through the bloodstream or otherwise affects the whole body. Examples include chemotherapy, hormone treatment, targeted treatment, and immunotherapy; it differs from local treatment such as surgery or focused radiation.

Systemic Vascular Resistance

The aggregate resistance to blood flow through the systemic circulation, regulated mainly by the tone of small arteries and arterioles. It contributes to mean arterial pressure and the resistance the left ventricle pumps against.

Systemic Vasculitis

A group of disorders involving inflammation and damage of blood-vessel walls. It can affect vessels of different sizes, narrowing or weakening them and impairing blood flow; manifestations vary with the vessels and organs involved.

Alternate Names:
Generalized Vasculitis

Systemic Venous

Systemic venous refers to veins returning deoxygenated blood from the body to the right side of the heart, excluding the pulmonary circulation.

Systole

The part of each heartbeat when a heart chamber contracts and pushes blood forward. Ventricular systole sends blood to the lungs and body, while arterial pressure rises and the heart's valves coordinate flow.

Systolic

Systolic means relating to contraction of the heart, especially the pressure in arteries when the ventricles eject blood.

Systolic Anterior Motion

Movement of the mitral valve toward the path where blood leaves the heart during each heartbeat. It can partly block blood flow and cause the valve to leak, especially in hypertrophic cardiomyopathy. Symptoms may include breathlessness, chest pain, dizziness, or fainting; treatment depends on the cause and severity.

Alternate Names:
SAM; SAM of the Mitral Valve

Systolic Murmur

An abnormal auscultatory heart sound heard during cardiac ventricular systole (between the first heart sound, S_1, and second heart sound, S_2), produced by turbulent blood flow. Subdivided into midsystolic (ejection) murmurs (typically crescendo-decrescendo, caused by aortic stenosis, pulmonary stenosis, or benign physiologic flow) and holosystolic (pansystolic) murmurs (plateau-shaped, beginning at S_1 and continuing through S_2, caused by mitral regurgitation, tricuspid regurgitation, or ventricular septal defect).

Alternate Names:
Systolic Murmurs

Systolic Murmurs

Plural form; see *Systolic Murmur*.

Systolic Pressure

The maximum arterial pressure during ventricular contraction, recorded as the upper number of a blood-pressure reading.

T

T1 Mapping

A quantitative cardiac MRI technique that measures longitudinal relaxation times in heart muscle. Native (pre-contrast) and post-contrast measurements help characterize tissue changes such as edema, fibrosis, or infiltration; values depend on the scanner and sequence used.

T2 Mapping

A quantitative cardiac MRI technique that measures the transverse relaxation time of heart tissue. Prolonged myocardial T2 often reflects increased tissue water, such as edema or inflammation.

T3

Triiodothyronine, the more active of the main thyroid hormones. It helps control how quickly the body uses energy and supports normal growth, development, heart activity, and body temperature.

T3RU Test

A legacy thyroid-function blood test that estimates unoccupied thyroid-hormone binding sites on serum proteins, especially thyroxine-binding globulin. It does not measure serum T3. Historically, the result was combined with total T4 to calculate the free thyroxine index; direct free-T4 and TSH assays have largely replaced this use.

T3 Test

A blood test measuring triiodothyronine, used with thyroid-stimulating hormone and thyroxine to evaluate thyroid function, particularly suspected hyperthyroidism.

T4

Thyroxine, the main hormone released by the thyroid gland. Much of it is changed into the more active T3 in body tissues. T4 helps control energy use, growth, development, and body temperature.

Tabes Dorsalis

A late nervous-system complication of untreated syphilis that damages sensory nerves and parts of the spinal cord. It can cause severe brief pains, numbness, poor balance, loss of reflexes, and bladder or sexual problems.

Tablet

A solid medicine made to be swallowed, chewed, dissolved in the mouth, or used in another specified way. Some tablets release medicine immediately, while others are coated or designed to release it slowly.

Tablet Splitting

Dividing a tablet into smaller parts. Extended-release, enteric-coated, and some specialized tablets may release medicine incorrectly or become unsafe when split.

TAB Vaccine

An older vaccine against typhoid fever and paratyphoid A and B. It has largely been replaced by newer typhoid vaccines and does not protect against every cause of fever or every type of paratyphoid infection.

Tacalcitol

A vitamin-D-like medicine applied to skin affected

by psoriasis or selected scaling disorders. It helps regulate skin-cell growth and inflammation but can irritate skin or raise calcium if overused.

Tache Noire

A dark scab or area of dead tissue at the site of a tick bite. It can occur with some spotted-fever infections and is interpreted with fever, rash, travel, and exposure history.

Tachyarrhythmia

An abnormally fast heart rhythm, which may arise from the atria, ventricles, or the heart's conduction system. Symptoms can include palpitations, dizziness, chest discomfort, shortness of breath, or fainting; severe cases can impair circulation or cause cardiac arrest.

Tachycardia

A heart rate faster than expected for a person's age and situation. It may be a normal response to exercise, stress, fever, or dehydration, or may result from a heart or other medical problem.

Alternate Names:
Rapid Heartbeat; Fast Heart Rate

Tachycardia-Bradycardia Syndrome

A variant manifestation of sick sinus syndrome characterized by alternating paroxysmal supraventricular tachyarrhythmias (commonly atrial fibrillation or atrial flutter) and periods of severe sinus bradycardia or prolonged sinus pauses upon arrhythmia termination.

Alternate Names:
Tachy-Brady Syndrome

Tachycardia-Induced Cardiomyopathy

Weakening and dilation of the heart muscle caused by a persistent or frequently recurring rapid heart rhythm, often improving when the arrhythmia is controlled.

Tachykinin

A family of small signaling proteins, including substance P, that help regulate pain, inflammation, smooth-muscle activity, and communication between nerve cells.

Tachyphrenia

Tachyphrenia is rapid flow of thoughts or accelerated mental activity, often described in association with mania, stimulants, or other psychiatric states.

Tachyphylaxis

A rapid loss of a medicine's effect after repeated doses over a short time. It differs from tolerance, which usually develops more slowly; the effect may return after the medicine-free interval is lengthened.

Tachypnea

Abnormally rapid breathing. It may occur with exercise or anxiety, but can also signal fever, low oxygen, pneumonia, blood clot in the lung, heart failure, severe infection, pain, or acid buildup.

Tachypnoea

Breathing faster than expected for a person's age and situation. It may result from exercise, fever, pain, anxiety, lung disease, low oxygen, heart failure, severe infection, or acid buildup; its significance depends on the cause and other findings.

Tachysystole

More than five uterine contractions in 10 minutes, averaged over 30 minutes, during labor. It can reduce the baby's oxygen supply, especially when the fetal heart rate is abnormal, and may follow medicines used to start or strengthen labor.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Tachysystole; Excessive Uterine Activity

TACO

Transfusion-associated circulatory overload is acute or worsening breathing difficulty caused by a rise in hydrostatic pressure after transfusion, usually with pulmonary edema. It typically begins during or within 12 hours after transfusion and may include high blood pressure and fluid overload; heart or kidney disease increases risk.

TAC Regimen

A chemotherapy combination of docetaxel, doxorubicin, and cyclophosphamide, used for selected breast cancers; it can cause infection risk, nausea, hair loss, heart effects, and other toxicities.

Tacrolimus

A medicine that suppresses immune activity. It is used to prevent rejection after an organ transplant and, in different preparations, to treat eczema and some other inflammatory skin conditions; infection risk and other side effects require monitoring.

Tactile

Relating to the sense of touch, including feeling pressure, texture, vibration, temperature, or pain. Touch signals travel through nerves to the brain; reduced or abnormal touch sensation may result from nerve, spinal-cord, brain, or skin disease.

Tactile Agnosia

Inability to recognize a familiar object by touch even though basic sensation is intact. It usually results from a problem in areas of the brain that interpret sensory information.

Tactile Fremitus

Vibrations felt on the chest when a person speaks. Changes in these vibrations can help clinicians identify lung problems such as pneumonia, fluid around the lung, a collapsed lung, or reduced air movement.

Tactile Sense

The ability to perceive touch, pressure, vibration, texture, and related mechanical stimuli through receptors in the skin and deeper tissues.

Tadalafil

Tadalafil is a phosphodiesterase-5 inhibitor used for erectile dysfunction, benign prostatic hyperplasia, and pulmonary hypertension; headache, flushing, hypotension, priapism, and dangerous nitrate interactions are important risks.

Taenia

A group of tapeworms that includes Taenia solium, the pork tapeworm, and Taenia saginata, the beef tapeworm. Adult worms can live in the intestine; T. solium eggs can also cause cysts in body tissues.

Taenia Saginata

Taenia saginata is the beef tapeworm acquired from undercooked infected beef; intestinal infection may cause abdominal symptoms or passage of motile segments but does not usually cause human cysticercosis.

Taeniasis

Intestinal infection caused by adult *Taenia* tapeworms. It is usually acquired by eating undercooked beef or pork containing larval cysts. It may cause abdominal discomfort, nausea, diarrhea, or passage of worm segments. Swallowing *Taenia solium* eggs causes cysticercosis in tissues, which is a different infection.

Taenia Solium

A pork tapeworm that infects people who eat undercooked pork or swallow its eggs. Adult worms live in the intestine, while eggs can cause cysticercosis, including dangerous infection of the brain.

Tailbone Trauma

Injury to the coccyx, the small bone at the bottom of the spine, usually after a fall or prolonged pressure. It causes pain when sitting, standing, or passing stool. Most injuries are bruises and improve over time; persistent or severe pain may indicate a fracture or another problem.

Tail Of The Epididymis

The lower part of the epididymis where mature sperm are stored before entering the vas deferens.

Takayasu Arteritis

An immune-mediated large-vessel vasculitis affecting the aorta and its major branches. Inflammation can narrow, block, or weaken these arteries, causing limb pain with use, weak or unequal pulses, blood-pressure differences, bruits, fever, fatigue, vision or

neurological symptoms, or organ ischemia.

Takayasu Disease

A large-vessel vasculitis that primarily affects the aorta and its major branches. It may cause limb claudication, weak or unequal pulses, blood-pressure differences, bruits, fever, fatigue, or arterial narrowing and aneurysms. Imaging and inflammatory assessment guide immunosuppressive and vascular treatment.

Takayasu'S Arteritis

Inflammation of the aorta and its major branches that can narrow or weaken the arteries. It may cause weak pulses, unequal blood pressure, arm or leg pain with use, fever, fatigue, or high blood pressure.

Takotsubo Cardiomyopathy

A temporary heart condition often triggered by severe emotional distress or intense physical stress, earning it the common name "broken heart syndrome." A sudden flood of stress hormones causes the main pumping chamber of the heart (the left ventricle) to temporarily enlarge and weaken, taking on a ballooned shape that resembles a traditional Japanese octopus trap (takotsubo). It closely mimics the symptoms of a heart attack—causing sudden chest pain, shortness of breath, and abnormal heart rhythms—even though coronary arteries are not blocked by blood clots.

Alternate Names:
Broken Heart Syndrome; Stress-Induced Cardiomyopathy; Apical Ballooning Syndrome

Takotsubo Syndrome

A temporary weakening of the heart muscle often triggered by intense emotional or physical stress. It can resemble an acute heart attack with chest pain, breathlessness, and ECG changes. Coronary artery disease can coexist, but an acute blockage does not explain the heart-muscle changes; complications can include heart failure, arrhythmia, or shock.

Alternate Names:
Stress Cardiomyopathy; Broken-Heart Syndrome

Talactoferrin Alfa

Talactoferrin alfa is a recombinant lactoferrin-related immunomodulatory protein studied as a treatment or adjunct in cancer and infectious disease.

Talaporfin Sodium

Talaporfin sodium is a photosensitizer used or studied in photodynamic therapy, where light activation produces local cytotoxic effects.

Talar Dome Lesion

An injury or defect involving the cartilage and underlying bone at the top of the talus. It may follow an ankle injury or develop through repeated loading and can cause persistent ankle pain, swelling, or catching.

Alternate Names:
Osteochondral Lesion of the Talus; Osteochondral Defect of the Talus

Talar Tilt Test

An examination that gently tilts the ankle inward or outward to assess ligament support, especially the calcaneofibular ligament. Excessive tilt or a clear difference from the other ankle may suggest ligament injury; the result is interpreted with the history and other examination findings.

Alternate Names:
Inversion Stress Test of Ankle; CFL Integrity Test

Talc

A soft mineral; inhalation of talc dust can cause talcosis, and contaminated injected talc can injure vessels and lungs.

Talcosis

Lung damage caused by breathing talc dust or, rarely, injecting talc-containing crushed medicines. It can cause scarring, cough, and shortness of breath; severity depends on the amount and type of exposure.

Talcum Powder Poisoning

Harmful effects from swallowing or inhaling talcum

powder. Swallowing usually causes mild stomach upset, but inhaling it can injure the lungs and make breathing difficult.

Talipes

A deformity of the foot and ankle present at birth or acquired later. It may affect position, flexibility, walking, and shoe fit, and treatment depends on severity, cause, age, and function.

Talipes Calcaneovalgus

A foot deformity in which the heel is turned outward and the ankle is dorsiflexed so the foot points upward; flexible newborn cases often improve, while rigid cases may reflect a structural abnormality.

Talipes Equinovarus

A congenital foot deformity with ankle plantar flexion (equinus), heel inversion (varus), and inward deviation of the forefoot (adduction), often with a high arch. It is the common rigid form of clubfoot and may affect one or both feet.

Tall Stature

Tall stature means height substantially above the expected range for age and sex and may be familial, endocrine, genetic, or associated with another condition.

Talofibular Ligament Injury

Sprain or tear of one or more ligaments connecting the fibula to the talus, especially the anterior talofibular ligament on the outer ankle. It commonly follows an inversion injury and may cause pain, swelling, bruising, or instability.

Talus

The ankle bone between the shinbones and the heel and foot bones. It transfers body weight through the ankle and has a limited blood supply, so some fractures can damage the bone and cause delayed healing or bone death.

Tamoxifen

A medicine that blocks or changes oestrogen effects in breast tissue. It treats and helps prevent some breast cancers, but can increase the risk of blood clots and, rarely, cancer of the uterine lining.

Tamoxifen Citrate

The citrate salt of tamoxifen, a selective estrogen-receptor modulator used to treat or prevent some breast cancers; blood clots and endometrial cancer are important uncommon risks.

Tamoxifen Toxicity

Adverse pharmacological effects of the selective estrogen receptor modulator tamoxifen used in breast cancer treatment, including hot flashes, increased risk of deep vein thrombosis and pulmonary embolism, and endometrial hyperplasia/carcinoma via agonistic estrogenic effects on the uterus.

Tampon

A material inserted into the vagina to absorb menstrual blood; prolonged use can rarely lead to toxic shock syndrome.

Tamponade

Pressure on an organ caused by accumulated fluid, blood, or gas. Cardiac tamponade occurs when fluid or blood around the heart prevents it from filling and pumping properly.

Tamsulosin Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride salt of tamsulosin, an alpha-1 blocker that relaxes prostate and bladder-neck muscle to improve urinary symptoms from benign prostatic enlargement.

Tangier Disease

A rare inherited disorder causing extremely low HDL cholesterol and buildup of cholesterol in tissues. It may cause enlarged yellow-orange tonsils, enlarged liver or spleen, nerve symptoms, or clouding of the cornea; cardiovascular risk varies and specialist testing is needed.

Tanner Staging

A five-stage scale describing physical changes during

puberty, including breast or genital development and pubic hair. It helps clinicians assess whether development is absent, typical, early, delayed, or progressing unevenly.

Tantalum

A corrosion-resistant metal used in some surgical implants and medical devices; exposure risk depends on the form, dose, and route.

Tapentadol

A prescription pain medicine with opioid-like and nerve-signal effects, used for selected moderate or severe pain. It can cause sleepiness, constipation, dependence, seizures, and dangerously slow breathing, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Tapeworm

A parasitic flatworm with a segmented body that may live in the intestine or form larval cysts in tissues. People acquire different species by eating infected meat or fish or by ingesting eggs from contaminated sources. Symptoms and complications depend on the species and site.

Tapeworm Infection

Infection caused by parasitic tapeworms. Taenia species may live as adult worms in the intestine, while some tapeworm larvae can form cysts in tissues.

Tapotement

A massage technique using rhythmic tapping, patting, or percussion. It can worsen injury or bleeding in some situations.

Tapping

Repeated light striking or percussion used during an examination, treatment, or test. It may help assess reflexes, pain, body sounds, or fluid and can also be used in chest physiotherapy or other treatments.

TAPSE

Alternate name; see *Tricuspid Annular Plane Systolic Excursion*.

TAPVR

Alternate name; see *Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Return*.

Tarantula Spider Bite

A bite from a tarantula that usually causes local pain, redness, and swelling. Some species also release irritating hairs that can affect the skin or eyes.

Tardieu Spots

Small pinpoint hemorrhages, classically seen beneath the lung or heart coverings in some deaths involving increased venous pressure. They are nonspecific and cannot by themselves establish the cause or timing of death.

Alternate Names:
Subpleural Ecchymoses; Petechial Hemorrhages

Tardive Dyskinesia

A delayed-onset movement disorder associated with prolonged use of dopamine-blocking medicines, especially antipsychotics. It causes involuntary, repetitive movements, often of the tongue, face, or jaw, and sometimes the limbs or trunk; these may persist or worsen after the medicine is stopped.

Tardive Dystonia

A persistent or recurrent movement disorder caused by prolonged exposure to dopamine-receptor-blocking medicines. Sustained twisting postures or repetitive muscle contractions may affect the neck, trunk, face, or limbs.

Tardive Oral Dyskinesia

Involuntary repetitive movements of the mouth, tongue, jaw, or face that develop after prolonged exposure to dopamine-blocking medicines. It may persist after the medicine is stopped or even after dose reduction.

Target Cell

An abnormal morphologic erythrocyte (codocyte) characterized by a disproportionate excess of cell membrane relative to intracellular hemoglobin content, producing a distinctive microscopic “bull’s-eye”

appearance with a central area of hemoglobin surrounded by a clear ring and an outer hemoglobinized rim. Characteristically observed on peripheral blood smear in hemoglobinopathies (thalassemia syndromes, hemoglobin C disease, sickle cell disease), severe iron deficiency anemia, obstructive liver disease (due to increased membrane cholesterol), and post-splenectomy states.

Alternate Names:
Target Cells; Codocyte; Codocytes

Target Cells

Plural form; see *Target Cell*.

Target-Controlled Infusion

A computer-controlled pump that adjusts the rate of an intravenous medicine to reach and maintain a planned concentration in the blood or at its site of action. It is used mainly during anesthesia and requires close monitoring.

Targeted Radiation Therapy

Radiation directed precisely at a tumor or other abnormal tissue to damage its DNA while limiting exposure to nearby healthy tissue. It may be delivered from outside the body or through an implanted source.

Targeted Temperature Management

Careful control of body temperature after cardiac arrest or another critical illness, usually in an unconscious patient. It aims to limit further brain injury and requires continuous monitoring while the person is cooled or kept from developing fever.

Targeted Therapies For Cancer

Cancer medicines designed to act on specific features of cancer cells or their surroundings. They may be more selective than traditional chemotherapy, but can still cause important side effects.

Targeted Therapy

Treatment that acts on a specific change or feature helping cancer cells grow, survive, or spread. Testing the tumor may identify a target and predict benefit. These treatments can be more selective than traditional chemotherapy but may still cause serious side effects and resistance.

Target Organ

An organ especially affected by a disease, hormone, toxin, medicine, or other exposure. Effects may occur because the organ has specific receptors, receives the substance, or is especially vulnerable to damage.

Target Sign

A classic cross-sectional ultrasonographic and CT finding of intussusception characterized by concentric alternating hyperechoic and hypoechoic rings formed by the invaginating bowel (intussuscipiens and intussusceptum) with mesenteric fat and fluid ('donut sign').

Alternate Names:
Donut Sign of Intussusception; Bullseye Sign

Target Tissue

Tissue that responds to a hormone, medicine, toxin, or other signal because its cells have the appropriate receptor or molecular target. The response may change growth, activity, metabolism, or survival.

Tarlov Cyst

A cerebrospinal fluid-filled perineural dilational sac arising between the perineurium and endoneurium of posterior spinal nerve roots, most frequently occurring at the S2 and S3 sacral levels. Arising from arachnoid proliferation or venous hydrostatic hypertension, the cyst cavity characteristically contains neural elements (nerve root fibers) within its wall or lumen. While frequently incidental on sacral MRI, enlarging cysts can produce symptomatic sacral radiculopathy, low back pain, perineal numbness (saddle anesthesia), sciatica, and neurogenic bladder or bowel dysfunction.

Alternate Names:
Tarlov Cysts; Perineural Cyst; Sacral Nerve Root Cyst

Tarlov Cysts

Plural form; see *Tarlov Cyst*.

Tar Remover Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing, inhaling, or skin contact with tar-removing chemicals. Effects vary by product and may include irritation, dizziness, vomiting, or breathing problems.

Tars

A thick black substance from organic material; tobacco tar contains chemicals that can damage lungs and cause cancer.

Tarsal

Relating to the tarsus, the group of bones forming the ankle and hindfoot. Tarsal bones help support body weight and allow foot movement.

Tarsal Bones

The seven bones of the hindfoot and midfoot that connect the ankle to the metatarsals and form the arches and load-bearing framework of the foot.

Alternate Names:
Tarsus

Tarsal Coalition

An abnormal connection between two foot bones, usually present from birth. It can make the foot stiff or flat and cause pain, repeated ankle sprains, or difficulty walking, often becoming noticeable during adolescence.

Tarsal Cyst

A fluid-filled or other cystic lesion in the ankle or foot region, which may cause a lump, pain, pressure, or nerve symptoms. Examination and imaging determine whether it is a ganglion, synovial cyst, or another lesion.

Tarsal Joints

The articulations among the tarsal bones and between the tarsals and metatarsals, providing stability and controlled movement for walking and adapting the foot to surfaces.

Tarsal Tunnel Syndrome

Pressure on the tibial nerve as it passes through a narrow space near the inner ankle. It can cause burning pain, tingling, or numbness in the sole and may result from injury, swelling, diabetes, or a mass. Treatment depends on the cause.

Tarsorrhaphy

A procedure that partially or completely closes the eyelids to protect the cornea or reduce exposure in conditions such as severe dry eye or facial nerve palsy.

Tar Staining

A yellowish-brown discoloration observed on the fingers, fingernails, or facial hair caused by prolonged cutaneous deposition of tar and nicotine particulates from cigarette smoking. It serves as an objective physical sign of chronic heavy tobacco consumption.

Tarsus

The group of seven bones forming the ankle and the back and middle parts of the foot. These bones connect the lower-leg bones to the metatarsals and help support body weight, absorb forces, and adapt the foot during walking.

TAR Syndrome

Thrombocytopenia-absent-radius syndrome, an inherited condition causing low platelet counts and absent or severely shortened radius bones in the forearms. It may also cause limb differences, heart defects, kidney problems, or milk intolerance.

Tartar

A hard deposit of mineralized dental plaque, also called calculus.

Tarui Disease

A rare inherited muscle-energy disorder caused by deficiency of an enzyme needed to break down sugar for energy. Exercise can trigger early fatigue, cramps, muscle breakdown, and dark urine; some people also have chronic anemia or high uric acid.

Alternate Names:
Glycogen Storage Disease Type VII (GSD VII); Muscle Phosphofructokinase Deficiency

Tassinari Syndrome

An older term for a childhood epilepsy disorder with frequent abnormal brain activity during sleep, seizures, and possible effects on learning or development. Modern clinicians usually use a more specific diagnosis based on the child's seizures and sleep recording.

Taste

The sensation produced by the interaction of chemical substances with taste receptor cells (TRCs) on the tongue, palate, pharynx, epiglottis, and upper esophagus. Taste is one of the five primary senses (gustation).

Taste Bud

A taste bud is a cluster of specialized sensory cells in papillae of the tongue and some oral tissues that detects sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami stimuli and transmits signals through cranial nerves.

Taste Disorder

Abnormal reduction, loss, distortion, or unpleasant alteration of taste, caused by infection, medications, oral disease, nerve injury, neurologic disease, or other factors.

Taste Receptor

A sensor on taste-bud cells that detects chemicals in food and helps produce the sensations of sweet, salty, sour, bitter, and savory (umami). Signals then travel through nerves to the brain.

Tattoos

Tattoos are permanent designs made by placing pigment into the skin. Risks include infection, allergic reactions, scarring, and difficulty removing the pigment.

Taurine

Taurine is a sulfur-containing compound involved in normal cell, nerve, muscle, and bile-acid function. It is present in foods and added to some energy drinks; high caffeine intake in such drinks can be harmful.

Taurodontism

A tooth-development difference with an enlarged pulp chamber and shortened roots, usually affecting molars. It may occur alone or with genetic conditions and can complicate dental treatment or root-canal procedures.

Taussig-Bing Anomaly

A rare birth defect in which both major arteries leave the right lower heart chamber and a hole lies between the lower chambers below the pulmonary artery. It can cause severe low oxygen and heart failure in infancy and usually requires early specialist surgery.

Alternate Names:
Taussig-Bing Syndrome; DORV with Subpulmonic VSD

TAVR

Alternate name; see *Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement*.

Taxanes

Chemotherapy medicines, including paclitaxel and docetaxel, that disrupt cell division by stabilizing tiny internal structures. They treat several cancers but may cause low blood counts, nerve symptoms, hair loss, allergic reactions, or fluid retention.

Tay-Sachs Disease

A rare autosomal recessive lysosomal storage disorder usually caused by disease-causing variants in the *HEXA* gene. Reduced or absent beta-hexosaminidase A activity prevents normal breakdown of GM2 ganglioside, which accumulates mainly in neurons. The infantile form causes progressive loss of previously acquired skills, weakness, an exaggerated startle response, seizures, and vision changes; juvenile and late-onset forms may progress more slowly and have variable movement, speech, psychiatric, or cognitive features.

Alternate Names:
GM2 Gangliosidosis Type 1 Hexosaminidase A Deficiency HEXA Deficiency

Tazarotene

A topical retinoid used for acne, plaque psoriasis, and some sun-damaged skin. It can irritate skin and increases sun sensitivity; pregnancy precautions are important.

TB

Alternate name; see *Tuberculosis*.

TBG Blood Test

A blood test measuring thyroxine-binding globulin, the principal thyroid-hormone transport protein; it helps interpret abnormal total thyroid-hormone levels when binding-protein changes are suspected.

TBI

Alternate name; see *Traumatic Brain Injury*.

TBM

Abbreviation; see *Tuberculous Meningitis*.

TB Test

A tuberculosis test looks for infection with Mycobacterium tuberculosis using a skin test, blood test, or examination of respiratory specimens.

TB (Tuberculosis)

Alternate name; see *Tuberculosis*.

TCA Cycle

A series of chemical reactions inside cells that breaks down products of carbohydrates, fats, and proteins. It produces carbon dioxide and energy-carrying molecules used to make the cell's energy supply.

T Cell

A type of white blood cell that matures in the thymus and helps protect the body from infections and abnormal cells. Some T cells kill infected cells, while others coordinate or limit immune responses.

T-Cell

A thymus-derived lymphocyte that constitutes the primary effector of cell-mediated adaptive immunity. Characterized by surface expression of the antigen-specific T-cell receptor (TCR) complex coupled to CD3 signaling chains, T cells undergo positive and negative selection in the thymic cortex and medulla. Subsets include CD4+ T helper cells (Th1, Th2, Th17, and T-regulatory cells producing distinct cytokine profiles), CD8+ cytotoxic T lymphocytes (mediating targeted apoptosis of virally infected and neoplastic cells via perforin and granzymes), and memory T cells providing long-term immunologic memory.

Alternate Names:
T-Cells; T Lymphocyte; T Lymphocytes

T-Cell Count

A laboratory measurement of T lymphocytes in blood, often including CD4 cells, used to assess immune function and monitor conditions such as HIV infection or immunosuppression.

T-Cell Lymphoma

A type of blood cancer that develops from abnormal T lymphocytes, specialized white blood cells that normally help the immune system fight infections. In T-cell lymphoma, these cells grow and divide uncontrollably, accumulating in lymph nodes, skin, bone marrow, or other organs. It can present either as a skin-based lymphoma causing persistent itchy patches, plaques, or tumors, or as a systemic lymphoma causing swollen lymph nodes, fever, drenching night sweats, and weight loss.

Alternate Names:
T-Cell Lymphomas; Peripheral T-Cell Lymphoma; PTCL

T-Cell Lymphomas

Plural form; see *T-Cell Lymphoma*.

T-Cell Receptor

A protein on a T cell that recognizes a particular piece of a germ or abnormal cell when another cell displays it. This recognition helps start or direct a targeted immune response.

T-Cells

Plural form; see *T-Cell*.

TCOF1

A gene in which disease-causing variants can produce Treacher Collins syndrome, a craniofacial developmental disorder. Genetic counseling and assessment of breathing, hearing, vision, feeding, and speech may be needed.

TCS

Abbreviation; see *Treacher Collins Syndrome*.

Td

Td is a vaccine protecting against tetanus and diphtheria, generally used as a booster in adolescents and adults according to local schedules.

Tdap Vaccination In Pregnancy

Administration of tetanus, diphtheria, and acellular pertussis (Tdap) vaccine during each pregnancy, optimally at 27-36 weeks. The goal: boost maternal antibodies to protect the newborn from pertussis (whooping cough) before the infant can be vaccinated at 2 months.

Td Immunization

Vaccination against tetanus and reduced-dose diphtheria, used for routine boosters, catch-up immunization, and wound-related protection according to age and vaccination history.

Tear

A split or rupture in tissue, such as a muscle, tendon, ligament, meniscus, skin, or organ, caused by trauma, overuse, degeneration, or pressure.

Teardrop Cells

Red blood cells shaped like teardrops on a blood smear. They may occur when the bone marrow is scarred or crowded by another disease, but they are not specific to one condition.

Alternate Names:
Dacrocytes; Tear-Drop Poikilocytes

Tear Duct Reconstruction

Surgery to repair or rebuild part of the lacrimal drainage system to restore tear flow, often after injury or blockage. Depending on the site, it may repair a drainage channel or create a new route from the tear sac into the nose.

Tear Film Break-Up Time

A quantitative clinical ophthalmologic test measuring tear film stability and evaporative dry eye; after instilling topical fluorescein, the interval between a complete blink and the appearance of the first dry black spot in the pre-corneal tear film under cobalt blue light is timed (normal greater than 10 seconds; less than 10 seconds indicates tear film instability).

Alternate Names:
TBUT; Tear Breakup Assay

Tearing

Excessive production or inadequate drainage of tears, commonly caused by irritation, allergy, dry-eye reflex tearing, infection, eyelid malposition, or lacrimal-duct obstruction.

Tears

Fluid made mainly by the lacrimal glands that lubricates, nourishes, cleans, and protects the eye's surface. Tears contain water, salts, oils, mucus, and immune substances that help maintain clear, comfortable vision.

Technetium-99

A radioactive form of technetium that changes slowly by radioactive decay and is related to technetium-99m, the more widely used imaging isotope. Technetium isotopes are used in nuclear medicine and research.

Technetium-99M

A short-lived radioactive form of technetium used in many nuclear-medicine scans. It is attached to different substances so doctors can examine bones, the heart, kidneys, brain, or other organs; the radiation is detected by a special camera.

Technique

The method, equipment, and sequence of steps used for a medical examination, procedure, or imaging study. Correct technique improves safety, accuracy,

and consistency of results.

Tectum

The dorsal roof plate of the midbrain located posterior to the cerebral aqueduct, composed of the paired superior colliculi (mediating visual orientation reflexes and saccades) and inferior colliculi (relaying auditory pathways).

Alternate Names:
Tectum Mesencephali; Quadrigeminal Plate

TEE

TEE, or transesophageal echocardiography, uses an ultrasound probe in the esophagus to obtain detailed images of heart valves, chambers, clots, and nearby vessels.

Teenage Pregnancy

Pregnancy in a person aged 19 years or younger. Compared with adult pregnancy, it may carry higher risks of anemia, high blood pressure, preterm birth, and low birth weight, although outcomes improve with timely prenatal care and support.

Teenagers And Drugs

Psychoactive substance use during adolescence is associated with risks to brain development, mental health, safety, education, and social functioning. The effects vary with the substance, frequency and duration of use, age at exposure, and individual vulnerability; substance-use disorders may also develop.

Teenagers And Sleep

Teenagers commonly need about eight to ten hours of sleep, but schedules, screens, caffeine, mood, school demands, and sleep disorders can reduce sleep quality.

Teen Depression

Depression in an adolescent, causing persistent sadness, irritability, loss of interest, low energy, sleep or appetite changes, hopelessness, or thoughts of death. Symptoms persist long enough to impair school, relationships, or daily life.

Alternate Names:
Adolescent Depression

TEER

Alternate name; see *Transcatheter Edge-To-Edge Repair*.

Teeth

Hard, mineralized structures in the mouth used for cutting, tearing, and grinding food. They are held in the jaw by surrounding bone and gums and can be affected by decay, infection, injury, or wear.

Teeth Grinding

Alternate name; see *Bruxism*.

Teeth-Grinding

Alternate name; see *Bruxism*.

Teething

Teething is eruption of an infant's primary teeth through the gums and may cause gum discomfort, drooling, and chewing; high fever or severe illness suggests another cause.

Teichopsia

A visual disturbance involving shimmering zigzags, flashing patterns, or fortress-like shapes. It commonly occurs as a migraine aura but can have other causes, especially when new, persistent, or associated with vision loss.

Teicoplanin

A glycopeptide antibiotic used for selected serious infections caused by susceptible Gram-positive bacteria, including some resistant staphylococci. Kidney function and blood levels may need monitoring.

Telangiectasia

A visible, permanently dilated small blood vessel near the skin or mucosal surface, occurring alone or with conditions such as rosacea, liver disease, or inherited vascular syndromes.

Telangiectasis

Widening of small blood vessels near the skin or a moist body lining, producing visible red or purple lines or patches. Causes include sun exposure, rosacea, hormones, liver disease, and inherited conditions.

Teledermatology

Teledermatology is the use of video, photographs, or other digital communication to assess and manage skin conditions remotely. Some problems still require an in-person examination or biopsy.

Telegraphic Speech

A style of verbal expression in which speech consists predominantly of content words (nouns and verbs) with omission of grammatical morphemes, prepositions, conjunctions, and auxiliary verbs, resembling a telegram. It is characteristic of expressive (Broca) non-fluent aphasia.

Telehealth

Delivery of healthcare through secure electronic communication or remote monitoring, including video visits, telephone care, messaging, and transmission of clinical data.

Telemedicine

Delivery of medical care at a distance using information and communication technology. It may include video or telephone consultations, secure messages, remote diagnosis, treatment, and review of clinical information.

Teleradiology

The remote review of medical images, such as X-rays, CT scans, or MRI scans, by a qualified radiologist who is not at the imaging site. It can provide urgent or specialist interpretation when local expertise is unavailable and must protect patient information.

Tele-Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation provided remotely through video visits, phone calls, apps, or monitoring devices. It may include assessment, home exercises, education, and progress checks when in-person care is difficult to access.

Telogen and Anagen Effluvium

Diffuse, usually nonscarring hair shedding caused by premature entry of follicles into the resting telogen phase or abrupt injury to actively growing anagen follicles. Telogen shedding commonly follows illness or stress after a delay, whereas anagen shedding can begin within days to weeks of chemotherapy, radiation, or toxin exposure.

Telogen Effluvium

A common, non-scarring form of diffuse hair shedding that occurs when more hairs than usual enter the resting (telogen) phase. Shedding often begins 2–4 months after illness, fever, surgery, childbirth, major stress, rapid weight loss, nutritional deficiency, or certain medicines. It is usually temporary, with regrowth after the trigger is corrected, although recovery may take several months.

Telomere

A protective DNA region at the end of each chromosome. It helps keep genetic material stable during cell division and usually becomes shorter as cells divide and age.

Temazepam

A sedative medicine sometimes used for short-term insomnia. It can cause drowsiness, poor coordination, memory problems, dependence, and dangerously slow breathing, especially when combined with alcohol, opioids, or other sedatives.

Temperature

A measurement of body heat. The result varies with the measurement site, time, activity, age, and illness.

Temperature Measurement

Measurement of body or environmental temperature using a thermometer or sensor at a specified site, interpreted with method, age, timing, and clinical context.

Temple

The region of the skull at the side of the head between the forehead and ear.

Temple Syndrome

A genomic-imprinting disorder involving chromosome 14q32 that causes prenatal and postnatal growth restriction, hypotonia, developmental delay, feeding difficulty, short stature, and abnormal pubertal development.

Temporal

Relating either to time or to the temple area on the side of the skull, including the temporal lobe.

Temporal Arteritis

Inflammation of arteries, especially those at the temples, usually in adults over 50. It may cause a new headache, scalp tenderness, jaw pain while chewing, fever, or vision problems and can threaten sight.

Temporal Arteritis Pathology

Granulomatous inflammation of medium and large arteries, often with disruption of the internal elastic lamina, intimal hyperplasia, medial inflammation, and giant cells. Biopsy findings may be segmental and can persist after treatment.

Temporal Artery

An artery running along the side of the scalp, supplying nearby tissues; inflammation can cause temporal arteritis.

Temporal Bones

The two skull bones on the sides and base of the head. They contain the ear structures and passages for important nerves and blood vessels and help protect the brain.

Temporalis

A broad muscle on each side of the head, over the temple. It helps close the jaw for chewing; its back fibers also pull the lower jaw backward.

Alternate Names:

Temporal Muscle

Temporal Lobe

One of the main areas on each side of the brain, near the ears. It helps process sounds, understand language, form memories, and process emotions.

Temporal Lobe Epilepsy

Epilepsy in which seizures begin in the part of the brain near the ears that helps process memory, emotion, and sound. Episodes may cause unusual feelings, déjà vu, staring, loss of awareness, or repetitive movements.

Temporal Lobe Seizure

A seizure that begins in the temporal lobe of the brain and may cause altered awareness, unusual sensations, or repetitive movements.

Temporary Blindness

A transient loss of vision in one or both eyes. It can result from retinal or brain ischemia, migraine, seizures, changes in blood pressure, eye disease, or other causes; sudden loss can signal a vascular or neurologic emergency.

Temporary Loss Of Consciousness

A brief period of unresponsiveness with loss of posture, followed by recovery. Fainting is common, but seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, low blood sugar, and other illnesses can also cause it; recurrent episodes may reflect an underlying disorder.

Temporary Unconsciousness

A brief episode of loss of awareness and responsiveness, often caused by syncope but also possible with seizure, concussion, hypoglycemia, or other conditions requiring assessment.

Temporomandibular Disorders

Alternate name; see *TMJ Disorder*.

Temporomandibular Joint

The jaw joint in front of each ear, where the lower jaw meets the skull. It allows the mouth to open,

close, and move side to side; problems can cause pain, clicking, stiffness, or limited movement.

Temporomandibular Joint Disorder

Alternate name; see *TMJ Disorder*.

Temporomandibular Joint Dysfunction

A musculoskeletal disorder affecting the temporomandibular joint, articular disc, and masticatory muscles, characterized by preauricular facial pain, clicking or crepitus on jaw movement, and restricted mandibular opening.

Alternate Names:
TMD; TMJ Syndrome

Temporomandibular Joint Replacement

Surgery that removes a severely damaged jaw joint and replaces it with an artificial joint. It may be considered for ankylosis, advanced joint destruction, or persistent severe symptoms after other treatments have failed.

Temporomandibular Joint Syndrome

Pain or dysfunction involving the jaw joint and chewing muscles, often causing jaw pain, clicking, restricted opening, headache, or tooth-related symptoms. Causes include clenching, trauma, arthritis, and stress-related muscle tension. Persistent locking, severe pain, or inability to eat can occur in more serious jaw or dental conditions.

TEN

Alternate name; see *Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis*.

Tenascin

A group of proteins in the tissue surrounding cells that help organize tissue structure and influence growth, healing, and inflammation. Levels may change in wounds, developing tissues, and some tumors.

Tender

Painful or sensitive when touched or pressed, a finding that may indicate inflammation, infection, trauma, ischemia, or another underlying process.

Tenderness

Pain or discomfort caused by pressing or touching a body part. It may indicate inflammation, injury, infection, or another local or systemic problem.

Tendinitis

Inflammation of a tendon, often associated with overuse or injury. It can cause localized tenderness, stiffness, swelling, or pain with movement. Tendinopathy is a broader term for tendon disease and does not always involve active inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Tendonitis

Tendinopathy

Pain and abnormal structure or function of a tendon, often related to repeated loading, aging, or injury. It can cause localized tenderness, stiffness, weakness, or pain with movement and does not necessarily involve active inflammation.

Tendinosis

Long-lasting wear and disorganization of tendon tissue, usually from repeated loading or an injury rather than sudden inflammation. It can cause pain and reduced strength.

Tendon

A strong band of tissue that connects a muscle to a bone and transfers the muscle's pull to move a joint. Tendons have a limited blood supply, so some injuries heal slowly.

Tendon Injury

Damage to a tendon ranging from microscopic overuse injury to partial or complete rupture, causing localized pain, weakness, swelling, or loss of function.

Tendonitis

Alternate spelling; see *Tendinitis*.

Tendon Repair

Surgery to reconnect a torn tendon to itself or to bone so that movement can be restored. It is fol-

lowed by protected movement and rehabilitation; re-tearing, stiffness, weakness, infection, and nerve or vessel injury can occur.

Tendon Rupture

A partial or complete tear of a tendon, usually caused by sudden force, chronic tendon disease, or injury. It can cause sudden pain, swelling, weakness, and loss of the movement normally produced by that tendon.

Tendon Sheath

A thin lubricated covering around some tendons that reduces friction as the tendon moves; inflammation is called tenosynovitis.

Tendon Transfer

Surgical relocation of a functioning tendon to restore movement or balance when the original muscle-tendon unit is absent, paralyzed, or irreparable. Successful transfer requires an adequate donor, appropriate excursion, and a stable recipient joint.

Tendon Xanthoma

Firm, often painless cholesterol deposits in tendons, especially the Achilles tendons and tendons of the fingers. They can occur with inherited high cholesterol and other lipid disorders.

Alternate Names:
Tendinous Xanthoma; Achilles Tendon Xanthoma

Tenecteplase

A clot-dissolving medicine that helps restore blood flow during selected ischemic strokes and heart attacks. It is given through a vein, usually as one dose, but can cause serious bleeding, including bleeding in the brain.

Tenericutes

A former classification group for bacteria that lack a rigid cell wall, including Mycoplasma. The name is mainly used in older biological classifications; it is not a diagnosis or a routine clinical test result.

Tenesmus

A distressing sensation of needing to empty the bowel or bladder despite little output, commonly caused by rectal inflammation, infection, tumor, constipation, or urinary irritation.

Teniposide

Teniposide is a podophyllotoxin-derived antineoplastic drug that inhibits topoisomerase II and is used in selected leukemia or lymphoma regimens.

Tennis Elbow

Alternate name; see *Lateral Epicondylitis*.

Tennis Elbow Surgery

An operation to remove or repair damaged tendon tissue at the outer elbow when persistent tennis-elbow pain has not improved with nonsurgical care. Recovery requires rehabilitation, and pain, stiffness, nerve injury, or continued symptoms are possible.

Tenodesis

Surgical fixation of a tendon to bone or another tendon to restore function, stabilize a joint, or treat tendon imbalance.

Tenofovir

An antiviral medicine used with other drugs to treat HIV and, in some forms, to treat or prevent hepatitis B. It stops viruses copying their genetic material; kidney and bone effects require appropriate monitoring.

Tenosynovitis

Tenosynovitis is inflammation of the sheath surrounding a tendon, producing pain, swelling, and restricted gliding, commonly in the hand or wrist.

Tenotomy

Surgery that cuts or releases a tendon to reduce tightness, correct a deformity, relieve pressure, or change movement. It may be performed through a small opening or a larger incision; weakness, bleeding, infection, nerve injury, or recurrence can occur.

Tenovaginitis

Inflammation of a tendon and its surrounding sheath, also called tenosynovitis.

TENS

Abbreviation; see *Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation*.

Tensile Strength

The ability of a tissue or material to resist being pulled apart; it is important in wound healing and the integrity of sutures, tendons, and other connective tissues.

Tension

A pulling force or state of being stretched; in medicine it may describe tissue tension, blood-vessel wall tension, muscle tightness, or psychological strain depending on context.

Tension Headache

A common headache causing mild or moderate pressure or tightness, often on both sides or like a band around the head. It usually lacks vomiting and may be linked with stress, poor sleep, muscle tension, or prolonged screen or neck strain.

Tension Pneumothorax

A life-threatening medical emergency that occurs when air enters the pleural space between the lung and the chest wall and cannot escape, acting like a one-way valve. With each breath, rising air pressure collapses the affected lung and shifts the heart, windpipe, and major blood vessels toward the opposite side of the chest. This pressure kinks the large veins returning blood to the heart, causing sudden, severe breathing distress, a drastic drop in blood pressure, and cardiovascular collapse.

Tension-Type Headache

A common headache that usually causes mild or moderate pressure or tightness on both sides of the head. Routine activities usually do not make it worse, and nausea or vomiting are usually absent. Stress or poor sleep may contribute but do not define the headache type.

Tentorium

A strong fold of the brain's protective covering separating the cerebellum from the back parts of the cerebrum. It supports brain structures and contains an opening through which the brainstem passes.

Tentorium Cerebelli

A broad, crescent-shaped dural fold that arches over the posterior cranial fossa, physically separating the overlying occipital lobes of the cerebral hemispheres from the underlying cerebellum; its anterior free edge forms the tentorial notch (incisura).

Teprotumumab

A monoclonal antibody targeting the insulin-like growth factor 1 receptor and used to treat thyroid eye disease in selected patients.

Teratocarcinoma

An older term for a malignant mixed germ-cell tumor containing teratoma and embryonal carcinoma components. It most often arises in the testis; current pathology reports usually name the specific tumor components.

Teratogen

A medicine, chemical, infection, radiation exposure, or other influence that can harm an embryo or fetus and cause birth defects, growth problems, abnormal development, or pregnancy loss. Risk depends on the exposure, amount, timing, and individual factors.

Teratogenesis

The development of a birth defect, impaired growth, abnormal function, or pregnancy loss after harmful exposure during pregnancy. Risk depends on the substance or infection, amount, timing, route, and genetic factors; exposure does not automatically mean that harm will occur.

Teratogenic

Capable of causing congenital malformations, growth impairment, functional deficits, or pregnancy loss when an embryo or fetus is exposed during a vulnerable developmental period.

Teratogenic Drugs

Medicines that can harm an embryo or fetus and cause birth defects, poor growth, abnormal development, or pregnancy loss. The risk depends on the medicine, dose, timing, and stage of pregnancy.

Teratogenicity

The ability of a medicine, chemical, infection, or other exposure to harm an embryo or fetus. Risk depends on the substance, amount, timing, and individual factors; exposure does not guarantee harm.

Teratology and Drug Use During Pregnancy

Teratology is the study of how genetic, environmental, infectious, and medicine exposures can affect embryonic or fetal development. Risk depends on the substance, dose, timing, route, and maternal factors; abrupt medicine changes can also carry risks.

Teratoma

A tumor made of several types of tissue, such as skin, muscle, bone, or nerve tissue, because it develops from cells capable of forming different body tissues. It may be noncancerous or cancerous and can occur in the ovary, testicle, or other sites.

Teratozoospermia

Teratozoospermia is a high proportion of abnormally shaped sperm and may contribute to reduced fertility, though semen results must be interpreted as a whole.

Terazosin Hydrochloride

The hydrochloride salt of terazosin, an alpha-1 blocker used for urinary symptoms from benign prostatic enlargement and sometimes for hypertension; dizziness and first-dose fainting can occur.

Terbinafine

An antifungal medicine that damages the outer covering of fungi, stopping their growth or killing them. It is used on the skin or taken by mouth for selected fungal infections; liver problems and taste changes are possible.

Terbufos

Terbufos is a highly toxic organophosphate pesticide that inhibits acetylcholinesterase and can cause severe cholinergic poisoning.

Terbutaline

A beta-2 agonist used as a bronchodilator; it has limited and specialist use as a tocolytic.

Teres Major Muscle

A thick muscle of the posterior shoulder originating from the dorsal inferior angle of the scapula and inserting onto the medial lip of the intertubercular sulcus of the humerus; innervated by the lower subscapular nerve, it acts to adduct, medially rotate, and extend the arm.

Terfenadine

An older antihistamine withdrawn or restricted in many places because interactions and excessive blood levels can cause dangerous heart-rhythm abnormalities.

Teriparatide For Osteoporosis

An injectable medicine related to parathyroid hormone that stimulates new bone formation. It is used for selected people with severe osteoporosis or high fracture risk, usually for a limited period, and is followed by treatment that helps maintain the bone gained.

Terlipressin

A medicine similar to vasopressin that tightens certain blood vessels. It is used in selected hospital treatments for life-threatening bleeding from enlarged esophageal veins or kidney failure related to advanced liver disease; reduced blood flow and breathing problems are important risks.

Term

Relating to pregnancy from 37 weeks and 0 days through 41 weeks and 6 days. This period includes early term (37 weeks 0 days to 38 weeks 6 days), full term (39 weeks 0 days to 40 weeks 6 days), and late term (41 weeks 0 days to 41 weeks 6 days); 42 weeks and later is post-term.

Term Birth

Birth from 37 weeks and 0 days through 41 weeks and 6 days of pregnancy. Early term is 37 weeks 0 days to 38 weeks 6 days, full term is 39 weeks 0 days to 40 weeks 6 days, and late term is 41 weeks 0 days to 41 weeks 6 days; birth at 42 weeks or later is post-term.

Terminal Care

Care focused on comfort, symptom relief, dignity, and support for a person with an advanced illness who is approaching the end of life.

Terminal Delirium

Delirium occurring near the end of life, often caused by advanced organ failure, medication effects, metabolic disturbance, infection, or reduced cerebral perfusion. Management prioritizes comfort, reversible contributors when consistent with goals, and support for the patient and family.

Terminal Dribbling

A prolonged final part of urination in which the stream slows to a trickle or dribble. It is a voiding symptom, distinct from post-micturition dribbling, which is leakage after urination has finished; it may occur alongside weak stream or hesitancy.

Terminal Duct Lobular Unit

The smallest working unit of the breast, made of a small duct and the lobules connected to it. Many common breast changes and cancers begin in this area.

Terminal Ileitis

Inflammation of the distal ileum, commonly associated with Crohn disease but also caused by infection, ischemia, medication, or other inflammatory conditions and producing pain, diarrhea, or bleeding.

Terminal Illness

An advanced disease that is expected to lead to death, although the timing is uncertain and treatment may sometimes slow it. Care may focus on comfort, symptom relief, personal goals, and support for the patient and family.

Terminal Insomnia

Waking too early and being unable to return to sleep, a pattern that can occur in depression, circadian-rhythm disorders, aging, or other insomnia conditions.

Terry's Lines

Alternate name; see *Terry's Nails*.

Terry's Nails

An abnormal nail appearance in which the proximal eighty percent or more of the nail bed is opaque and chalky-white (apparent leukonychia) with obscuration of the lunula, bordered by a narrow distal band of pink or reddish-brown vascular nail bed. It is classically associated with liver cirrhosis, chronic congestive heart failure, type 2 diabetes mellitus, and systemic sclerosis, as well as normal aging.

Alternate Names:
Terry Nails; Terry's Lines; Terry Lines

Terson Syndrome

The occurrence of intraocular hemorrhage (subhyaloid, preretinal, or vitreous hemorrhage) in association with acute aneurysmal subarachnoid hemorrhage or severe traumatic brain injury, caused by sudden severe intracranial pressure elevation transmitted through the optic nerve sheath.

Alternate Names:
Terson's Syndrome; Subarachnoid Intraocular Hemorrhage

Tertian Fever

A fever that returns about every 48 hours. This pattern can occur with some malaria infections, especially those caused by *Plasmodium vivax* or *P. falciparum*; the pattern alone does not confirm malaria.

Tertiary Hyperparathyroidism

Persistent overproduction of parathyroid hormone after long-standing kidney disease or another cause of parathyroid overactivity. It can raise the blood calcium level and damage bones or kidneys.

Tertiary Prevention

Care that reduces complications, disability, or suffering from an established disease. Examples include rehabilitation, long-term disease management, preventing relapses, controlling symptoms, restoring function, and providing palliative care.

Testes

The paired male reproductive organs in the scrotum. They produce sperm and testosterone and may be affected by infection, injury, torsion, tumors, or disorders of development.

Testicle

The male primary reproductive gonad, suspended within the scrotum by the spermatic cord. Each testis is enclosed in a dense fibrous capsule (the tunica albuginea) and divided into lobules containing seminiferous tubules lined by Sertoli cells and developing germ cells (mediating spermatogenesis) and interstitial Leydig cells (synthesizing and secreting testosterone under luteinizing hormone [LH] stimulation). Normal scrotal position provides the sub-core temperature essential for optimal spermatogenesis; common pathologies encompass cryptorchidism, testicular torsion, epididymo-orchitis, varicocele, and testicular germ cell tumors.

Alternate Names:
Testicles; Testis; Testes

Testicle Lump

Alternate wording; see *Testicular Mass*.

Testicle Pain

Alternate name; see *Testicular Pain*.

Testicles

Plural form; see *Testicle*.

Testicular Appendage Torsion

Twisting of a small, nonessential remnant attached to the testicle or epididymis. It commonly causes localized scrotal pain and swelling in children and may produce a small tender blue spot under the scrotal skin.

Testicular Artery

An artery that supplies blood to a testis and travels in the spermatic cord.

Testicular Atrophy

Shrinkage of a testicle with loss of some functioning tissue. Causes include an undescended testicle, infection, twisting, injury, varicocele, hormone problems, aging, or other damage; it may reduce sperm or testosterone production.

Testicular Biopsy

Removal of a small sample of testicular tissue for microscopic examination, used selectively to evaluate infertility, atypical lesions, or suspected testicular disease.

Testicular Cancer

Cancer arising in a testicle, most often in younger adult men. It commonly appears as a painless lump, enlargement, heaviness, or ache. Ultrasound and blood tests help assess a suspected tumor; treatment is highly effective for many people, especially when found early.

Testicular Cancer In Children

Cancer arising in a child's testicle. It may appear as a painless lump, swelling, or enlargement; the tumor types and behavior differ with age.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Testicular Neoplasm; Pediatric Testicular Tumor

Testicular Choriocarcinoma

A rare, highly aggressive nonseminomatous germ-cell tumor containing trophoblastic cells. It often produces markedly elevated hCG and may spread early through the bloodstream, including to the lungs or brain.

Testicular Descent

The movement of the testes from the abdomen into the scrotum before or soon after birth.

Testicular Diseases

Conditions affecting the testis, including twisting, infection, injury, tumors, blood-vessel problems, and abnormal development. Symptoms may include pain, swelling, a lump, fertility problems, or changes in hormone production.

Testicular Disorders

Conditions affecting the testes or surrounding structures, including torsion, infection, inflammation, trauma, tumors, and hormonal disorders. Symptoms may include pain, swelling, a mass, infertility, or changes in sexual development and require appropriate evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Testicular Pathology

Testicular Failure

Testicular failure occurs when the testes do not produce enough testosterone, sperm, or both. Causes include genetic conditions, injury, infection, medicines, and damage from chemotherapy or radiation.

Testicular Feminization

Outdated term for complete androgen insensitivity syndrome; see *Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome*.

Testicular Function

The two main jobs of the testes: making sperm and producing the sex hormone testosterone.

Testicular Gonadoblastoma

A rare tumor made from developing reproductive cells and supporting cells in an abnormally developed or undescended testicle. It is often associated with Y-chromosome material and may increase the risk of another germ-cell cancer.

Testicular Hydrocele

A buildup of clear fluid around a testicle, causing painless swelling of the scrotum. It may be present from birth or develop after injury, infection, inflammation, or another condition; examination helps exclude other causes of swelling.

Testicular Infection

Infection involving the testis, most often occurring with inflammation of the epididymis (epididymo-orchitis); isolated orchitis can also occur. It may cause scrotal pain, swelling, and fever and must be distinguished from testicular torsion.

Testicular Interstitium

The tissue between the seminiferous tubules. It contains Leydig cells, blood vessels, lymph vessels, and connective tissue.

Testicular Lobule

One of the small sections inside a testis that contains seminiferous tubules.

Testicular Mass

A lump or enlargement within or around a testicle caused by tumor, infection, inflammation, cyst, hematoma, or torsion. A solid mass within the testicle can be linked to cancer or another serious condition.

Testicular Microlithiasis

Multiple tiny calcifications within the testicular tissue seen on ultrasound. The finding alone does not establish cancer, and follow-up depends on other risk factors and clinical findings.

Testicular Pain

Pain in one or both testes, caused by torsion, infection, trauma, inflammation, hernia, tumor, or referred pain from nearby structures. Sudden, severe pain may indicate testicular torsion, which interrupts blood flow and can cause permanent testicular injury or loss without prompt treatment.

Testicular Self-Exam

A person's own examination of the testes for lumps, swelling, or changes in size or shape.

Testicular Seminoma

A malignant germ-cell tumor of the testis, usually affecting younger adults. It commonly presents as a painless testicular enlargement or mass; diagno-

sis uses ultrasound, orchiectomy pathology, tumor markers, and staging imaging.

Testicular Torsion

Twisting of the spermatic cord that cuts off blood flow to a testicle. It usually causes sudden, severe one-sided scrotal pain and swelling, sometimes with nausea or vomiting. It is a surgical emergency; prolonged loss of blood flow can cause permanent testicular injury or loss.

Alternate Names:
Torsion of Spermatic Cord; Testis Twisting

Testicular Torsion Emergency

Alternate name; see *Testicular Torsion*.

Testicular Torsion Overview

Alternate name; see *Testicular Torsion*.

Testicular Torsion Repair

Urgent surgery to untwist a spermatic cord and restore testicular blood flow, followed by fixation of the affected and usually opposite testis to prevent recurrence.

Testicular Trauma

Injury to a testicle caused by a blow, crush injury, penetrating wound, or other force. It may cause pain, swelling, bruising, bleeding, or rupture of the tough covering around the testicle.

Testicular Tumor

Alternate name; see *Testicular Cancer*.

Testicular Vein

A vein that drains blood from a testis through the spermatic cord. The right and left sides drain into different larger veins.

Testis

One of the two male reproductive glands in the scrotum. It produces sperm and testosterone and is surrounded by protective tissue. Sudden pain, swelling, or a new lump can indicate torsion, infection, or a tumor.

Alternate Names:
Male Gonad; Orchis

Testis Disorder

A condition affecting a testicle, including torsion, infection, tumor, trauma, infertility-related damage, hormonal dysfunction, or abnormal development.

Testis Neoplasm

A tumor arising in testicular tissue, most commonly a germ-cell tumor in younger adults; painless enlargement, heaviness, or a solid mass may occur and is commonly investigated with ultrasound.

Test Meal

A meal with known ingredients and amounts given before measuring a body response, such as stomach emptying, acid production, blood sugar, or hormone release. The person follows specific preparation and timing instructions.

Testosterone

A steroid sex hormone produced mainly by the testes and, in smaller amounts, by the ovaries and adrenal glands. It supports reproductive development, muscle and bone maintenance, red-blood-cell production, libido, and other physiologic functions; levels vary with age, sex, time of day, illness, and medicines.

Testosterone Deficiency

Alternate name; see *Male Hypogonadism*.

Testosterone Propionate

A short-acting injectable testosterone ester used in selected hormone-replacement or androgen-deficiency settings; risks include erythrocytosis, infertility, acne, mood effects, and prostate-related monitoring needs.

Tests For H Pylori

Tests for Helicobacter pylori infection, including urea breath testing, stool antigen testing, biopsy-based testing, or selected blood tests; choice depends on treatment and clinical context.

Test Strips

Narrow strips containing chemicals that react with a sample to measure or detect a substance. Common examples test urine for blood or infection, or test blood for glucose or ketones. Results can be affected by storage, timing, contamination, and incorrect use.

Tetanus

A serious and potentially fatal bacterial infection caused by a potent nerve toxin produced by *Clostridium tetani*, a bacterium commonly found in soil, dust, and animal manure that can enter the body through puncture wounds, cuts, or animal bites. The toxin travels along nerves to the spinal cord and brainstem, where it blocks normal inhibitory nerve signals. This leads to continuous, agonizing muscle spasms, starting with the jaw and neck (lockjaw), causing difficulty swallowing, rigid arching of the spine, and potentially fatal breathing muscle paralysis.

Alternate Names:
Lockjaw; Clostridium tetani Infection

Tetanus Toxin

A toxin made by the bacterium Clostridium tetani. It blocks calming signals in the nervous system, causing painful muscle stiffness and spasms, including lockjaw. Vaccination and proper wound care reduce the risk of tetanus.

Tetany

Muscle cramps, spasms, or twitching caused by increased nerve and muscle excitability, most often from low calcium or magnesium. Tingling around the mouth or in the hands may occur; severe spasms or breathing difficulty may occur in serious cases.

Tethered Cord Syndrome

A condition in which the spinal cord is abnormally attached and stretched inside the spinal canal. It may cause back or leg pain, weakness, numbness, foot changes, or bladder and bowel problems, sometimes worsening during growth.

Tetrabenazine

A medicine that reduces storage and release of certain brain chemicals involved in movement. It treats selected involuntary movement disorders but may cause sleepiness, depression, restlessness, stiffness, swallowing problems, or abnormal movements.

Tetracaine

Tetracaine is a potent ester local anaesthetic used topically or for spinal anaesthesia; excessive dose can cause seizures, cardiovascular toxicity, and methemoglobinaemia.

Tetrachloroethylene

Tetrachloroethylene, or perchloroethylene, is an industrial solvent used in dry cleaning; substantial exposure can affect the nervous system, liver, and kidneys.

Tetrachlorvinphos

An organophosphate insecticide that can block acetylcholinesterase. Significant exposure may cause sweating, vomiting, pinpoint pupils, muscle twitching, slow breathing, seizures, or coma.

Tetracycline

A class of broad-spectrum antibiotics used to treat a wide range of bacterial infections, including respiratory tract infections, skin conditions such as severe acne, and tick-borne illnesses. They work by interfering with the ability of bacteria to produce the proteins necessary for growth and multiplication. Because they bind to calcium, they can cause permanent tooth discoloration and affect bone growth, and are therefore avoided in young children and during pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Tetracyclines

Tetracyclines

Plural form; see *Tetracycline*.

Tetracycline Stain

Gray, yellow, or brown tooth discolouration caused by tetracycline-family antibiotics taken while teeth

are developing. The colour is within the tooth and may require professional whitening, veneers, or crowns for cosmetic improvement.

Tetrahydrozoline Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing eye drops or nasal drops containing tetrahydrozoline. It can cause extreme sleepiness, slow heart rate, low blood pressure, and breathing problems, especially in children.

Tetralogy Of Fallot

A congenital heart defect comprising a ventricular septal defect, obstruction of the right ventricular outflow tract (usually pulmonary stenosis), an overriding aorta that receives blood from both ventricles, and right ventricular hypertrophy. The obstruction can reduce blood flow to the lungs and lower blood oxygen levels.

Tetraplegia

Paralysis or severe weakness affecting both arms and both legs, usually because the spinal cord in the neck has been injured or damaged by disease. Trunk movement, sensation, breathing, and bladder or bowel control may also be affected.

Tet Spell

A sudden episode of severe bluish coloring and low oxygen in a child with unrepaired tetralogy of Fallot. Crying, feeding, or exertion may trigger it; the child may breathe rapidly, become limp, or faint. It is an emergency requiring calming, positioning, oxygen, and urgent specialist care.

Alternate Names:
Hypercyanotic Spell; Paroxysmal Dyspneic Attack; Blue Spell

TGA

Alternate name; see *Transient Global Amnesia*.

Th1/Th2/Th17/Tfh/Treg Balance

A description of how several types of helper immune cells work together. They help fight infections, support antibody production, promote inflammation, or limit excessive immune activity; disruption may contribute to allergy or autoimmune disease.

Thalamic Pain Syndrome

A central neuropathic pain syndrome developing weeks to months after a cerebrovascular infarct involving the ventral posterolateral (VPL) nucleus of the thalamus (posterior cerebral artery occlusion), characterized by burning, allodynic, and severe intractable contralateral hemibody pain.

Alternate Names:
Dejerine-Roussy Syndrome

Thalamus

A pair of structures deep within the brain that relay most sensory information, such as touch, vision, and hearing, to the outer brain. They also help regulate movement, alertness, and memory.

Thalassaemia

Alternate spelling; see *Thalassemia*.

Thalassemia

A group of inherited blood disorders in which the body makes too little of one part of hemoglobin, the oxygen-carrying protein in red blood cells. This causes anemia, ranging from mild to severe, and may require regular treatment.

Thalassemia Major

A severe inherited blood disorder in which the body makes too little hemoglobin. It causes serious anemia beginning in childhood and may require regular blood transfusions, with monitoring for iron buildup and organ damage.

Thalidomide

A medicine that changes immune activity and is used for selected cancers and inflammatory conditions. It can cause severe birth defects, nerve damage, blood clots, sleepiness, and other harms, requiring strict safety controls.

Thallium

Thallium is a toxic heavy metal that can cause gastrointestinal illness followed by painful nerve damage, hair loss, skin changes, kidney or liver injury, seizures, and heart or brain problems.

Alternate Names:
Thallium Toxicity; Thallotoxicosis

Thallium-201

A radioactive substance sometimes used in heart-blood-flow scans. Heart muscle takes it up in relation to its blood supply, and a special camera shows areas receiving less blood.

Thallium-201 Stress Test

A nuclear cardiac-perfusion test in which thallium-201 or a comparable tracer is used with stress imaging to identify areas of reduced blood flow or nonviable heart muscle.

Thallium Poisoning

Alternate name; see *Thallium*.

Thallium Scan

A nuclear-medicine test using thallium-201 to show blood flow to heart muscle or selected tumors. It is now less common because other tracers are often preferred, but may still have specific uses.

Thallium Toxicity

Heavy-metal poisoning that may begin with gastrointestinal symptoms and progress to painful sensorimotor neuropathy, encephalopathy, alopecia, and nail changes such as Mees lines. Blood or urine testing supports diagnosis; treatment may include Prussian blue and supportive care.

Thanatophoric Dysplasia

A severe inherited disorder of bone growth causing extremely short limbs, a narrow chest, a large head, and abnormal skull and spine development. The small chest can prevent adequate breathing after birth and is often life-threatening.

Theca

A connective-tissue sheath, especially the theca surrounding an ovarian follicle.

Theca Lutein Cyst

A usually temporary ovarian cyst caused by strong stimulation from pregnancy-related hormones or fertility treatment. It is often present in both ovaries and may cause abdominal pressure or pain; it commonly shrinks when hormone levels return to normal.

Thecoma

A usually benign ovarian sex-cord stromal tumor composed of theca-like cells, often producing estrogen and presenting with abnormal uterine bleeding or an incidental adnexal mass.

Thelarche

The onset of breast development, usually the first visible sign of female puberty. It commonly begins between ages 8 and 13, with substantial normal variation.

Thelaziasis

Infection of the eye by nematode worms of the genus *Thelazia*, usually transmitted by flies that feed on tears. The worms live in the conjunctival sac, the pocket between the eyelid and eyeball, and may cause a foreign-body sensation, tearing, or conjunctivitis. Human infection is uncommon; these parasites mainly infect animals.

Thenar Eminence

The fleshy mound at the base of the thumb, formed by muscles that move the thumb. Damage to the supplying nerve or muscles can weaken thumb opposition and make grasping difficult.

Theophylline

A medicine that can relax airway muscles and improve breathing in selected lung diseases. Its safe and harmful doses are close together, so blood levels, medicine interactions, heart rhythm, and side effects need monitoring.

Theophylline Toxicity

Toxicity causing persistent nausea and vomiting, tremor, agitation, tachycardia, hypokalemia, hyperglycemia, seizures, or life-threatening atrial or ventricular dysrhythmias. Measure serial serum levels and electrolytes; benzodiazepines treat seizures,

repeated activated charcoal may reduce absorption, and hemodialysis is considered for severe poisoning.

Theranostic Pair

Two related medical substances designed to find and treat the same target in the body. One helps show where the target is on an image; the other delivers treatment to cells carrying that target.

Theranostics

A medical approach that uses one targeted substance to find abnormal cells and a related substance to treat them. In some cancers, the treatment substance carries radiation directly to cells with the target.

Therapeutic Abortion

Induced ending of a pregnancy for a medical reason, such as a serious risk to the pregnant person's health or a condition affecting the fetus. The term is also called medically indicated abortion.

Therapeutic Alliance

The working relationship between a patient and a therapist. It includes trust, agreement about treatment goals, and cooperation on the steps of therapy, and can influence how well treatment works.

Therapeutic Drug Monitoring

Measuring the concentration of selected medicines in blood to guide dosing and reduce harm. Samples must be taken at the right time for the medicine and interpreted with the dose, symptoms, and clinical context; not every medicine requires monitoring.

Alternate Names:
TDM; Serum Drug Level Monitoring

Therapeutic Equivalence

Two medicine products are therapeutically equivalent when they contain the same active ingredient, have the same strength and dosage form, meet quality standards, and are expected to have the same clinical effect when used as directed.

Therapeutic Exercise

Planned physical activity used to improve strength, flexibility, balance, movement, endurance, or daily function and to reduce pain or disability. A clinician selects and gradually adjusts exercises according to the person's condition, abilities, symptoms, and goals.

Therapeutic Hypothermia

Deliberate, closely monitored lowering of body temperature, used in selected clinical situations such as temperature control after cardiac arrest and in newborns with hypoxic-ischemic encephalopathy. The target and duration depend on the condition; cooling can cause shivering, abnormal heart rhythms, or electrolyte changes.

Therapeutic Index

A measure of how close a medicine's effective dose is to a dose that causes harm. With a narrow index, small changes in dose or blood concentration can cause toxicity or loss of effect.

Therapeutics

The part of medicine concerned with treating disease and improving health. It includes medicines, procedures, surgery, rehabilitation, and other treatments used to prevent, control, or cure illness.

Therapeutic Window

The range of medicine exposure that is high enough to work but low enough to avoid unacceptable harm. Medicines with a narrow window can cause toxicity or treatment failure after small changes in dose or blood level.

Therapy

Treatment intended to prevent, relieve, or cure disease or to improve function and quality of life.

Thermal Injury

Tissue damage caused by heat, including burns and scalds. Severity depends on temperature, contact time, depth, body area, and involvement of the airway or other structures.

Alternate Names:
Heat Injury; Thermal Trauma

Thermal Therapy

Treatment using heat or cold to influence pain, swelling, muscle tension, or tissue temperature. Effects and safety depend on the condition and method used.

Thermogenesis

The production of heat by the body. It comes mainly from normal metabolism, muscle activity such as shivering, digestion, and specialized fat tissue that releases stored energy as heat.

Thermography

Recording the pattern of heat released from the body surface with a special camera. It may show temperature differences, but these are not specific to one disease.

Thermoluminescent Dosimeter

A small radiation-monitoring device that records accumulated exposure. When the device is heated, its detector releases light in proportion to the radiation it absorbed, allowing the exposure to be measured.

Thermometer Scales

Numbering systems used to report temperature, such as Celsius, Fahrenheit, and Kelvin. Temperatures can be converted between scales using defined formulas.

Thermoneutral Zone

The range of surrounding temperatures in which the body can maintain its normal temperature without shivering or sweating. The range varies with clothing, activity, age, health, and humidity.

Thermoplasty

A procedure for selected adults with severe asthma that uses controlled heat delivered through a bronchoscope to reduce extra muscle in the airway walls. It may reduce severe attacks but does not cure asthma and has procedural risks.

Thermoreceptor

A nerve ending that senses warmth or cold in the skin and other tissues. Signals travel through the spinal cord to the brain, helping a person recognize temperature and helping the body control heat through sweating, shivering, and changes in skin blood flow. Damage to these nerves can reduce temperature sensation and increase the risk of burns or cold injury.

Thermoregulation

The body's control of internal temperature by balancing heat production and heat loss. It uses sweating, shivering, changes in skin blood flow, behavior, and brain signals to keep temperature within a safe range.

Thiabendazole

An antiparasitic medicine used for selected worm infections and, historically, some fungal infections. It can cause nausea, dizziness, liver problems, or nervous-system effects and is now used less often because alternatives are available.

Thiamin

Alternate name; see *Thiamine*.

Thiamine

Vitamin B1, a water-soluble vitamin required for carbohydrate metabolism and nerve function. Severe deficiency can cause beriberi or Wernicke encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin B1; Aneurin

Thiamine Deficiency

A lack of vitamin B1, needed for normal nerve, heart, and energy metabolism. Causes include poor intake or absorption, heavy alcohol use, and increased requirements. Deficiency can cause beriberi, with nerve or heart problems, or Wernicke encephalopathy with confusion, abnormal eye movements, and poor coordination.

Thiazide Diuretics

Water tablets that make the kidneys remove more salt and water in urine. They are used mainly for high blood pressure and some fluid-retention disorders and can lower sodium or potassium levels.

Thiazide Overdose

Taking too much of a thiazide diuretic can cause dehydration, low blood pressure, abnormal sodium or potassium levels, confusion, or abnormal heart rhythms.

Thiazides

Water tablets that make the kidneys remove more salt and water in urine. They are used mainly for high blood pressure and some fluid-retention disorders and can lower sodium or potassium levels.

Thiazolidinedione Drugs

A group of diabetes medicines that make body tissues more sensitive to insulin by activating a protein called PPAR-gamma. Pioglitazone is the main example; possible effects include weight gain, swelling, bone fractures, and worsening heart failure.

Thiazolidinediones

A group of diabetes medicines that make the body more sensitive to insulin, helping lower blood glucose. They can cause weight gain and swelling and may worsen heart failure or increase fracture risk.

Thigh

The part of the lower limb between the hip and knee. It contains the femur, large muscles, major blood vessels, and nerves that help move and support the leg.

Thimerosal

A preservative containing ethylmercury that is used in some multidose vaccines and medical products. Ethylmercury leaves the body faster than methylmercury; its safety depends on the product, amount, and applicable regulations.

ThinPrep Pap Test

A cervical screening test in which cells collected from the cervix are placed in a liquid vial and examined for precancerous changes, cancer, or sometimes HPV-related abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
Liquid-Based Pap Test; Liquid-Based Cytology

Thiopental Sodium

A very short-acting anesthetic given through a vein to start general anesthesia or, in selected critical situations, reduce brain activity and pressure. It can dangerously slow breathing, lower blood pressure, or cause allergic reactions.

Thiopentone Sodium

A very short-acting anesthetic medicine given into a vein to start general anesthesia in selected settings. It can suppress breathing, lower blood pressure, and cause allergic reactions, so close monitoring is required.

Thioridazine

An older antipsychotic medicine used only in selected situations because it can cause severe sleepiness, movement problems, and dangerous changes in heart rhythm, especially at high doses or with interacting medicines.

Thioridazine Overdose

Poisoning from taking too much thioridazine, an antipsychotic medicine. It can cause severe sleepiness, low blood pressure, seizures, and dangerous heart rhythms.

Thiotepa

A chemotherapy medicine that damages DNA and stops cells from multiplying. It is used for selected cancers and sometimes before a stem-cell transplant; side effects may include low blood counts, infection, nausea, mouth sores, and organ injury.

Third-Degree Atrioventricular Block

A serious heart-rhythm problem in which signals from the upper chambers do not reach the lower

chambers. The chambers beat independently, often causing a very slow pulse, fainting, or heart failure. A pacemaker is often used.

Alternate Names:
Complete Heart Block; Complete AV Block

Third-Degree AV Block

A severe heart-rhythm problem in which electrical signals from the upper heart chambers do not reach the lower chambers. The chambers beat independently, often causing a very slow pulse, dizziness, fainting, or collapse.

Third-Degree Burn

A full-thickness burn that destroys the epidermis and dermis and may extend into subcutaneous tissue. The skin may appear white, brown, or charred and sensation may be reduced. Assessment includes burn depth, extent, inhalation injury, and associated trauma; deep or extensive burns require specialist treatment and may need grafting.

Third-Degree Perineal Tear

A severe tear during vaginal birth that extends from the vaginal opening into the muscles controlling the anus. It is repaired after birth; pain, infection, difficulty controlling stool, or a fistula can result.

Alternate Names:
Third-Degree Obstetric Tear; OASIS

Third Heart Sound

A low-pitched extra heart sound heard in early diastole during rapid ventricular filling, shortly after the second heart sound. It can be a normal finding in children and younger adults; in older adults, it is generally associated with ventricular dysfunction or volume overload.

Third Stage Of Labor

The part of childbirth between the baby's birth and delivery of the placenta. The placenta normally separates and is delivered within minutes; heavy bleeding or a placenta that does not deliver may occur with complications.

Third Trimester

The period of pregnancy from 28 weeks until birth. The fetus grows rapidly and continues developing its lungs, brain, and other organs. Prenatal visits monitor blood pressure, growth, movement, and symptoms; tests and screening are scheduled according to local guidance and individual risk.

Thirst

The conscious desire to drink, regulated mainly by body-fluid concentration and circulating blood volume. Excessive thirst may occur with dehydration, diabetes, medicines, kidney problems, or other conditions.

Thomas Test

A physical examination manoeuvre used to assess for hip flexion contractures and tightness of the iliopsoas muscle. With the patient supine, one hip is fully flexed to flatten the lumbar lordosis; if the contralateral extended thigh lifts off the examination table, a fixed flexion deformity of that hip is present.

Thompson Test

A physical examination test (Simmonds-Thompson test) used to evaluate the integrity of the Achilles tendon; with the patient prone and feet hanging off the examination table, the examiner firmly squeezes the middle third of the calf musculature; absence of involuntary plantarflexion of the foot indicates a complete rupture of the Achilles tendon.

Alternate Names:
Simmonds Test; Calf Squeeze Test

Thomsen Disease

An inherited muscle disorder causing stiffness because muscles relax slowly after they contract. Symptoms often begin in childhood, affect the hands, legs, eyelids, or jaw, and improve after repeated movement. Strength and life expectancy are usually preserved, although stiffness can interfere with activity.

Alternate Names:
Autosomal Dominant Myotonia Congenita; Myotonia Congenita (Thomsen Type)

Thoracentesis

A medical procedure in which a thin needle or catheter is gently inserted through the back of the chest wall into the pleural space (the narrow gap between the lungs and the inner chest wall) to withdraw accumulated excess fluid (a pleural effusion). Thoracentesis is performed for two key reasons: diagnostic (collecting a small sample of fluid for laboratory analysis to find the underlying cause, such as pneumonia, heart failure, kidney disease, tuberculosis, or cancer) and therapeutic (removing a large volume of trapped fluid, typically 1 to 1.5 liters, to relieve pressure on a collapsed lung and rapidly ease shortness of breath and chest tightness). Often guided by real-time ultrasound to identify the safest insertion spot, the procedure is carried out under local anesthesia while the patient sits upright, carrying low risks when properly monitored.

Alternate Names:
Pleural Tap; Pleurocentesis; Pleural Fluid Aspiration; Thoracocentesis

Thoracic

Thoracic means relating to the chest, the thoracic spine, or structures within the thorax such as the heart and lungs.

Thoracic Aortic Aneurysm

A weakened, widened area of the aorta within the chest. It may cause no symptoms, but can cause chest or back pain or press on nearby structures; dissection or rupture can cause sudden severe pain, collapse, and life-threatening bleeding. Risk is increased by hypertension, inherited disorders, a bicuspid valve, or smoking.

Thoracic Cage

The bony and cartilaginous framework formed by the thoracic vertebrae, ribs, costal cartilages, and sternum. It protects thoracic organs and assists respiratory movements.

Thoracic Cavity

The space inside the chest, enclosed by the ribs and breathing muscles. It contains the lungs, heart, esophagus, trachea, major blood vessels, and other structures protected by the chest wall.

Thoracic Duct

The body's largest lymph vessel. It collects excess fluid and immune cells from most of the body and returns them to the bloodstream near the neck; injury can cause lymph fluid to leak into the chest.

Thoracic Ectopia Cordis

A congenital defect in which part or all of the heart lies outside the chest through an opening in the front chest wall, often involving a cleft or absent portion of the sternum. The heart may be exposed or partly covered by tissue, and other heart or midline abnormalities may also be present.

Thoracic Endometriosis

Endometriosis involving the chest, usually around the lung. Symptoms such as chest pain, breathlessness, or coughing may recur around menstruation and can rarely result in air or blood around the lung.

Thoracic Inlet

The upper opening of the chest, surrounded by the first thoracic vertebra, first ribs, and upper sternum. Major nerves, blood vessels, the airway, and the food pipe pass through it.

Thoracic Outlet

The lower opening of the chest, bordered by the lower ribs and diaphragm. It allows structures such as the aorta, food pipe, and large veins to pass between the chest and abdomen.

Thoracic Outlet Syndrome

Pressure on nerves or blood vessels as they pass from the neck into the arm. It may cause neck, shoulder, or arm pain, tingling, weakness, swelling, color change, or a cold hand. Treatment depends on the cause and may include physical therapy or surgery.

Alternate Names:
TOS; Neurovascular Compression of Thoracic Outlet

Thoracic Skeleton

The bony and cartilaginous framework of the chest, made up of the thoracic vertebrae, ribs, sternum, and costal cartilages.

Thoracic Spine

The middle part of the spine made up of the 12 thoracic vertebrae. It supports the ribs and protects the spinal cord in the chest region.

Thoracic Myelopathy

Spinal-cord dysfunction caused by damage or pressure in the mid-back region. Causes include spinal narrowing, a disc problem, a tumor, or injury. It can lead to leg stiffness or weakness, numbness, poor balance, difficulty walking, or bladder and bowel changes.

Thoracic Spondylosis

Age-related wear of the discs, joints, and bones in the middle part of the spine. It may cause stiffness or aching in the mid-back, but imaging changes often cause no symptoms. Bone spurs or disc changes can sometimes narrow space around the spinal cord or nerves.

Thoracic Spine CT Scan

Computed tomography of the thoracic spine used to evaluate vertebral fractures, alignment, bone lesions, spinal canal narrowing, and other bony abnormalities.

Thoracic Spine X-Ray

Plain radiographic imaging of the thoracic spine used to assess vertebral alignment, fractures, curvature, degenerative change, and selected bone lesions.

Thoracic Surgeon

A surgeon who performs operations on organs and structures in the chest, such as the lungs, esophagus, mediastinum, and sometimes the heart.

Thoracic Surgery

The surgical specialty concerned with operations on organs and structures in the chest, including the lungs, esophagus, mediastinum, and chest wall. Cardiac surgery may be a separate or integrated specialty, depending on the health system.

Thoracic Vertebrae

The twelve vertebrae of the chest region, each articulating with ribs and protecting the thoracic spinal cord while supporting the trunk and rib cage.

Thoracolumbar Spine Trauma

Injury to the middle or lower back. Doctors assess the bones, supporting ligaments, spinal cord, and nerves to determine whether the spine is stable and whether treatment needs a brace, monitoring, or surgery.

Thoracoscopy

A minimally invasive procedure using a camera inserted through the chest wall to examine or treat the pleura, lungs, or mediastinum.

Thoracotomy

A surgical incision into the chest wall to access the thoracic cavity (pleural space, lungs, heart, great vessels, esophagus, diaphragm, mediastinum).

Thorax

The thorax is the chest region between the neck and abdomen, enclosed by ribs and containing the heart, lungs, major vessels, and mediastinal structures.

Thought Blocking

An abrupt interruption in the train of thought before it is completed, as if the thought was removed or pushed out of the patient's mind. The patient may pause mid-sentence, appear confused, and report that the thought was "taken out" or "blocked." It is a formal thought disorder seen in schizophrenia.

Thought Disorder

A disruption in the organization, logical flow, or content of thinking, commonly manifesting as loose associations, neologisms, or tangentiality; see *Thought Disorders*.

Thought Disorders

Disturbances in the organization or content of thought. Formal thought disorder disrupts the flow or coherence of speech, as in derailment or incoherence; delusions are fixed false beliefs and are disturbances in thought content. These findings can occur in psychotic or mood disorders, neurologic disease, or substance effects.

Threadworm

In British and international terminology, the common parasitic pinworm (*Enterobius vermicularis*); in North American parasitology, it may also denote the intestinal nematode *Strongyloides stercoralis*. Transmitted through fecal-oral ingestion of infective eggs or cutaneous filariform larval penetration, female worms deposit eggs perianally to trigger intense nocturnal pruritus ani, excoriation, and restless sleep. Diagnosis is confirmed via the perianal cellophane tape test; treatment entails anthelmintics (pyrantel pamoate, albendazole, or mebendazole) with household contact coverage.

Alternate Names:
Threadworms; Pinworm; Enterobiasis

Threadworm Infection

An intestinal parasitic infection caused by Enterobius vermicularis, also called pinworm. Infection spreads when eggs are swallowed, often after contact with contaminated hands, bedding, food, or surfaces.

Threadworms

Plural form; see *Threadworm*.

Threatened Miscarriage

Vaginal bleeding during early pregnancy with a closed cervix and no passage of pregnancy tissue; the pregnancy may remain viable. Evaluation commonly includes clinical assessment, serial human chorionic gonadotropin testing when indicated, and ultrasound.

Alternate Names:
Threatened Abortion; Early Pregnancy Bleeding

Three-Day Measles

Alternate name; see *Rubella*.

Three-Dimensional Ultrasound

Ultrasound that combines many sound-wave measurements to create a three-dimensional image. It is used in obstetrics, gynecology, and other settings to show anatomy from several angles.

Three Swab Test

A diagnostic bedside test used to investigate continuous urine leakage from the vagina after pelvic surgery or childbirth. Three cotton swabs are placed inside the vagina and a colored dye (such as methylene blue) is put into the bladder; blue staining on the upper swabs indicates a bladder fistula (vesicovaginal fistula), whereas unstained urine indicates a leak from the ureter (ureterovaginal fistula).

Alternate Names:
Moir three-swab test; Three-swab test; Vaginal swab dye test.

Threonine

An essential amino acid used to build proteins and other body molecules. The body cannot make enough of it, so it must come from food.

Threshold

The lowest amount of a stimulus or measurement needed to produce a detectable response or effect.

Thrill

A palpable vibration over the chest or a blood vessel caused by turbulent blood flow.

Throat

The passage behind the mouth and nose that connects them with the voice box and esophagus. It carries air toward the lungs and food toward the stomach and contains the tonsils and other protective tissues.

Throat Cancer

Cancer arising in the pharynx or nearby structures of the throat. Persistent hoarseness, difficulty or

pain with swallowing, a neck lump, unexplained weight loss, or persistent sore throat requires medical evaluation, especially in people who use tobacco or alcohol.

Throat Or Larynx Cancer

Throat or larynx cancer is malignant growth in the pharynx or voice box and may cause persistent hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, pain, or a neck lump.

Throat Swab Culture

Culture of a throat specimen to detect bacterial pathogens, especially group A Streptococcus, when evaluating pharyngitis.

Alternate Names:
Throat Culture; Pharyngeal Swab Culture

Throbbing

A pulsating or beating quality of pain or another sensation. It can occur with migraine, inflammation, injury, infection, or increased awareness of a pulse.

Throckmorton Sign

A radiographic observation (John Thomas sign) in which the shadow of the male penis on an AP pelvis radiograph points toward the side of a unilateral hip or pelvic fracture.

Alternate Names:
John Thomas Sign; Penile Orientation Sign

Thrombectomy

A procedure to remove a blood clot from a blood vessel and restore blood flow. A catheter may remove the clot from a blocked brain artery during some ischemic strokes; surgery is used in selected other situations.

Thrombin

A blood-clotting substance that changes fibrinogen into fibrin, the protein threads that form a clot, and also activates platelets. The body makes thrombin after a blood vessel is injured; too much or too little clotting can cause disease.

Thrombin Time

A coagulation assay measuring the time required for plasma to form a fibrin clot after the addition of exogenous bovine or human thrombin, evaluating the final common pathway conversion of fibrinogen to fibrin, prolonged by heparin, dabigatran, hypofibrinogenemia, or dysfibrinogenemia.

Alternate Names:
TT; Thrombin Clotting Time

Thromboangiitis Obliterans

An inflammatory disease of small and medium blood vessels, strongly associated with tobacco use. It can cause pain, color changes, ulcers, or gangrene in the hands or feet. Complete tobacco cessation is essential; further treatment depends on ischemia, tissue loss, and other complications.

Alternate Names:
Buerger's Disease; Presenile Gangrene

Thrombocyte

Alternate name; see *Platelet*.

Alternate Names:
Thrombocytes; Platelet; Platelets

Thrombocytes

Plural form; see *Platelet*.

Thrombocythemia

Alternate name; see *Essential Thrombocythemia*.

Thrombocytopathy

A problem with how platelets work, even when the platelet count is normal or nearly normal. It may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or prolonged bleeding after an injury or procedure.

Thrombocytopenia

A low number of platelets, the blood cells that help stop bleeding. It may result from reduced production, increased destruction, trapping in an enlarged spleen, or dilution and can cause bruising, bleeding, or no symptoms.

Alternate Names:

Low Platelet Count

Thrombocytopenia in Pregnancy

A low platelet count during pregnancy or after delivery caused by gestational thrombocytopenia, immune thrombocytopenia, hypertensive disease, HELLP syndrome, infection, medicines, or another disorder. The cause and trend guide bleeding risk, treatment, anesthesia planning, and fetal evaluation.

Thrombocytopenic

Characterized by too few circulating platelets. It may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or other bleeding, although some people have no symptoms.

Thrombocytosis

A higher-than-normal number of platelets in the blood. It may be a temporary response to infection, inflammation, bleeding, or iron deficiency, or result from a bone-marrow disorder. It can increase bleeding or clotting risk depending on the cause.

Thromboelastography

A blood test that shows how quickly a clot forms, how strong it becomes, and how it dissolves. It can help guide blood-product treatment during severe bleeding, major surgery, or critical illness.

Thromboembolism

Obstruction of a blood vessel by a clot that formed elsewhere and traveled through the circulation.

Thromboembolism in Pregnancy

A blood clot in a vein or artery that may travel to the lungs or another organ during pregnancy or postpartum. Pregnancy increases venous thromboembolism risk; one-sided swelling, chest pain, sudden breathlessness, coughing blood, or collapse can indicate a clot.

Thrombolysis

The dissolution of a blood clot using a medicine such as a fibrinolytic agent. It is used only in selected conditions because it can cause serious bleeding.

Thrombolysis For PE

Emergency treatment using a clot-dissolving medicine for a life-threatening lung clot causing low blood pressure or shock. It can restore blood flow quickly but carries a serious risk of bleeding.

Thrombolysis For Stroke

Emergency treatment for selected strokes caused by a blood clot. A clot-dissolving medicine is given through a vein within a limited time after symptoms begin, after brain imaging excludes bleeding; serious bleeding is a possible complication.

Thrombolytic Agents

Medicines that dissolve an established blood clot by activating the body's clot-breaking system. They are reserved for selected emergencies because they can cause serious bleeding, including bleeding in the brain.

Alternate Names:
Thrombolytics; Clot-Dissolving Medicines

Thrombolytic Therapy

Treatment with a medicine that breaks down a blood clot and may restore blood flow in selected emergencies such as certain strokes, heart attacks, or lung clots. The main danger is serious bleeding, including bleeding in the brain.

Thrombophilia

A tendency for blood to form clots too easily. It may be inherited or develop with cancer, pregnancy, some medicines, inflammation, or other conditions and can increase the risk of clots in veins.

Thrombophilias in Pregnancy

Inherited or acquired tendencies toward abnormal blood clotting that can increase maternal venous thromboembolism risk and may be associated with placental complications. Testing and anticoagulation decisions depend on personal and family history, the specific thrombophilia, and pregnancy risk.

Thrombophilia Testing

Blood tests that look for inherited or acquired reasons a person may form blood clots too easily. Testing is considered selectively after a clot or with a strong family history because results may not change treatment.

Thrombophlebitis

Inflammation of a vein associated with a blood clot. Superficial thrombophlebitis may cause a tender, warm, red, firm cord along a vein just beneath the skin. Thrombosis in a deep vein can break away and cause a life-threatening pulmonary embolism; sudden limb swelling, chest pain, or breathlessness can indicate this complication.

Thrombopoiesis

The process by which the bone marrow makes platelets. Platelets develop from large marrow cells and enter the bloodstream, where they help stop bleeding.

Thrombosed Intracranial Aneurysm

A widened brain artery containing a blood clot. The clot may partly block the aneurysm but can also press on nearby brain structures, causing headache, vision or nerve problems, or seizures.

Thrombosis

Formation of a blood clot inside a blood vessel or the heart. The clot can block blood flow and damage tissue, causing problems such as deep-vein thrombosis, stroke, heart attack, or loss of blood supply to a limb.

Thrombosis Of The Inferior Vena Cava

A blood clot in the large vein that returns blood from the legs and abdomen to the heart. It may cause swelling in both legs or abdominal pain and can extend from a deep-vein clot.

Thrombotic Microangiopathy

A group of disorders in which tiny clots form in small blood vessels, damaging red blood cells and lowering the platelet count. The clots can injure the kidneys, brain, heart, or other organs. Causes include immune disorders, infections, medicines, pregnancy, and severe illness; urgent specialist treatment is often needed.

Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura

A rare, life-threatening blood disorder characterized by the formation of microscopic blood clots throughout the body's small blood vessels. It is most often caused by a deficiency or malfunction of an enzyme called ADAMTS13, which normally prevents blood-clotting proteins from clumping excessively. As tiny clots consume platelets and obstruct tiny blood vessels, they cut off blood supply to vital organs—such as the brain and kidneys—and shred passing red blood cells, leading to severe anemia, bleeding or purplish bruises on the skin, neurological symptoms, and kidney injury.

Alternate Names:
TTP; Moschcowitz Disease; ADAMTS13 Deficiency

Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura Pentad

The classic five findings once used to describe thrombotic thrombocytopenic purpura (TTP): hemolytic anemia, low platelet count, neurologic changes, kidney problems, and fever. Many people with TTP do not have all five findings, so their absence does not rule out TTP.

Alternate Names:
TTP Clinical Pentad; Moschcowitz Pentad

Thrombotic Vasculopathy

Damage to blood vessels caused by clots forming within them. It can reduce blood flow and injure skin or organs and may occur with autoimmune disease, severe infection, cancer, or disorders that cause widespread clotting.

Thromboxane

A chemical made mainly by activated platelets that makes platelets stick together and narrows blood vessels. These actions help stop bleeding but can also contribute to harmful clot formation.

Thrombus

A blood clot that forms inside a blood vessel or

the heart and remains attached where it formed. It may partly or completely block blood flow, or break loose and travel elsewhere as an embolus.

Thrombus Organization

The gradual healing of a blood clot as it is replaced by scar tissue and sometimes channels that allow blood to pass through again. This process can make an old clot firm and attached to the vessel wall.

Thrush

Alternate name; see *Oral Candidiasis*.

Thrush in Children

Thrush is Candida overgrowth in the mouth, producing white plaques, soreness, or feeding difficulty; Candida can also affect skin folds or diaper areas. Persistent, recurrent, severe, or immune-associated infection needs pediatric evaluation and appropriate antifungal treatment.

Thrush In Newborns

Oral Candida infection in an infant, causing white plaques on the tongue or mouth lining that may interfere with feeding and can be passed between infant and breastfeeding parent.

Thumb Arthritis

Degeneration or inflammation of a thumb joint, especially the joint at the base of the thumb, causing pain, stiffness, and reduced grip.

Alternate Names:
Basal Joint Arthritis; CMC Joint Arthritis

Thumb Carpometacarpal Arthritis

Arthritis of the carpometacarpal joint at the base of the thumb, often due to osteoarthritis. It can cause pain with pinching or gripping, stiffness, and reduced hand function.

Thumb CMC Arthritis

Arthritis of the joint at the base of the thumb, where the thumb meets the wrist. It causes pain with gripping or pinching, stiffness, swelling, and reduced hand strength; advanced disease may change the joint's shape.

Thumb-Sucking

A common childhood habit of sucking the thumb; persistent habit can affect dental and facial development.

Thymic Carcinoma

A malignant epithelial tumor of the thymus that is generally more aggressive and biologically distinct from thymoma. It may invade nearby structures or spread to other sites.

Thymic Hyperplasia

Thymic hyperplasia is enlargement of the thymus from increased lymphoid tissue or rebound growth and may be incidental. It can be associated with autoimmune disease, infection, endocrine conditions, or stress; imaging and clinical context distinguish it from a mass.

Thymic Neoplasm

An abnormal growth arising in the thymus. It may be a thymoma, thymic carcinoma, or another tumor; diagnosis depends on examination of tissue.

Thymine

Thymine is one of the four main bases in DNA. It pairs with adenine through hydrogen bonds and helps store genetic information.

Thymocyte

An immature T lymphocyte developing in the thymus, where it undergoes selection before becoming a mature T cell.

Thymoma

A tumor arising from the thymus, an immune-system organ behind the breastbone. It may cause chest pressure or no symptoms and is associated with conditions such as myasthenia gravis; behavior depends on whether it grows beyond the thymus.

Alternate Names:
Thymic Epithelial Tumor; Thymic Neoplasm

Thymus

An immune-system organ behind the breastbone where immature T cells mature and learn not to attack the body's own tissues. It is most active in childhood and becomes smaller after puberty.

Thymus Gland

An immune-system organ behind the breastbone where immature T lymphocytes learn to recognize harmful foreign material without attacking the body's own tissues. It is most active during childhood and gradually becomes smaller after puberty.

Thyrocalcitonin

Another name for calcitonin, a hormone made by thyroid C cells that lowers blood calcium mainly by reducing bone resorption.

Thyroglobulin Surveillance

Blood testing for thyroglobulin after treatment of some thyroid cancers. A rising or unexpectedly detectable level may suggest remaining or returning thyroid tissue, but results must be interpreted with the treatment history and antibody testing.

Thyroglossal Duct Cyst

A usually harmless, fluid-filled lump in the middle of the neck. It forms when a small channel used by the thyroid gland before birth does not fully disappear. The lump often moves when a person swallows or sticks out the tongue, and can become painful if infected.

Thyroid

An endocrine gland in the front of the neck that produces thyroid hormones, which regulate metabolism, growth, and development.

Thyroid Cancer

Cancer that develops in the tissues of the thyroid gland, the butterfly-shaped endocrine gland at the base of the neck that produces hormones regulating metabolism. Most thyroid cancers are slow-growing and highly treatable, often appearing as a painless lump or nodule in the neck, though larger tumors can cause a sensation of neck tightness, hoarseness, difficulty swallowing, or throat discomfort.

Alternate Names:
Thyroid Carcinoma; Malignant Thyroid Neoplasm

Thyroid Cancer Staging

The process of determining how far thyroid cancer has grown or spread. Doctors consider the tumor's size, nearby lymph nodes, distant spread, cancer type, age, and other features to guide treatment and estimate outlook.

Thyroid Cartilage

The largest cartilage of the larynx, formed by two plates that meet in front and create the laryngeal prominence. It protects the vocal folds and provides attachment for muscles and ligaments.

Thyroid Diseases

Conditions affecting the thyroid gland, including underactivity, overactivity, inflammation, enlargement, nodules, and cancer. They may change energy, weight, temperature tolerance, heart rate, bowel habits, mood, or neck appearance and are assessed with examination and blood tests.

Thyroid Disorders

Conditions affecting the thyroid gland, which makes hormones that regulate energy use, temperature, heart rate, growth, and development. Disorders may cause an underactive or overactive gland, inflammation, enlargement, nodules, or cancer.

Thyroid Drugs

Medicines that treat thyroid disorders. Thyroid hormone replacement, usually levothyroxine, treats an underactive thyroid; antithyroid medicines such as methimazole or propylthiouracil reduce hormone production in an overactive thyroid. The choice and monitoring depend on the condition and patient factors.

Alternate Names:
Thyroid Medicines; Thyroid Medication

Thyroidectomy

Surgery to remove part or all of the thyroid gland. It

may treat thyroid cancer, an overactive thyroid, or a large goiter; possible complications include bleeding, voice-nerve injury, and low calcium.

Thyroid Eye Disease

Alternate name; see *Dysthyroid Eye Disease*.

Thyroid Fine-Needle Aspiration

A procedure that uses a thin needle, usually guided by ultrasound, to remove cells from a thyroid lump. A laboratory examines the cells to help determine whether the lump is benign or needs further treatment.

Thyroid Follicular Carcinoma

A cancer arising from thyroid follicle cells and the second most common differentiated thyroid cancer. It tends to spread through blood vessels to the lungs or bones; diagnosis requires showing invasion of the capsule or blood vessels.

Thyroid Function Test

Singular variant; see *Thyroid Function Tests*.

Thyroid Function Tests

Blood tests, mainly thyroid-stimulating hormone and free T4, used to assess how well the thyroid is working. Results help identify an underactive or overactive thyroid but must be interpreted with symptoms and medicines.

Thyroid Gland

A butterfly-shaped gland at the front of the neck. It makes hormones that help control energy use, temperature, heart rate, growth, and development.

Thyroid Gland Enlargement

Alternate name; see *Goiter*.

Thyroid Gland Removal

Surgery to remove part or all of the thyroid gland for cancer, overactivity, a large goiter, or a suspicious nodule. Possible effects include bleeding, voice changes from nerve injury, low calcium, and the need for lifelong thyroid hormone.

Thyroid Hormone

A tyrosine-based, iodinated endocrine hormone synthesized and secreted by the follicular cells of the thyroid gland, primarily consisting of thyroxine (T_4, prohormone) and triiodothyronine (T_3, the biologically active form). Regulated by the hypothalamic-pituitary-thyroid axis via thyrotropin-releasing hormone (TRH) and thyroid-stimulating hormone (TSH), thyroid hormones bind nuclear thyroid hormone receptors (α and β) to stimulate basal metabolic rate, oxygen consumption, thermogenesis, lipolysis, protein turnover, and neurodevelopmental maturation in infants.

Alternate Names:
Thyroid Hormones; Thyroxine and Triiodothyronine

Thyroid Hormone Resistance

A rare disorder in which body tissues respond incompletely to thyroid hormones, usually because of an inherited change affecting a thyroid-hormone receptor. Blood levels of thyroid hormones are often high while TSH is not fully suppressed, and symptoms vary between people.

Thyroid Hormones

Plural form; see *Thyroid Hormone*.

Thyroid Hormone Toxicity

Clinical toxicity caused by excessive thyroid hormone activity, often from excessive replacement or other exogenous exposure. Symptoms may include palpitations, tremor, anxiety, heat intolerance, diarrhea, weight loss, arrhythmia, or severe thyrotoxicosis.

Thyroiditis

Inflammation or injury of the thyroid gland, caused by immune disease, infection, or some medicines. Some types release stored thyroid hormone and can first make hormone levels too high, then too low. Hashimoto disease often causes a lasting shortage of thyroid hormone. Some types cause neck pain and fever; others do not.

Thyroiditis Classification

Thyroid inflammation is classified by its cause and

pattern. Hashimoto disease is usually long-term and autoimmune; subacute thyroiditis is often painful and follows an infection; other forms may occur after childbirth, medicines, or injury.

Thyroid Lymphoma

A lymphoma arising in the thyroid, often in the setting of chronic autoimmune thyroiditis. It may present as a rapidly enlarging neck mass with swallowing or breathing difficulty; ultrasound, tissue biopsy, and staging distinguish it from thyroid carcinoma.

Thyroid Nodule

A discrete lesion within the thyroid parenchyma that is palpably or radiologically distinct from the surrounding thyroid tissue. Affecting up to 50–60% of the general adult population on high-resolution ultrasonography, the overwhelming majority ($> 90 - -95\%$) are benign (hyperplastic colloid nodules, thyroid cysts, or follicular adenomas). Initial diagnostic evaluation requires serum TSH (suppressed TSH prompting radionuclide scintigraphy to detect autonomous hyperfunctioning "hot" nodules) and high-resolution neck ultrasound utilizing the ACR TI-RADS system to assess suspicious features (hypoechogenicity, microcalcifications, taller-than-wide shape, irregular margins). Fine-needle aspiration (FNA) biopsy with Bethesda System cytopathology is performed for high-risk nodules to identify thyroid malignancy.

Alternate Names:
Thyroid Nodules

Thyroid Nodule Evaluation

Assessment of a lump in the thyroid using examination, thyroid blood tests, and ultrasound. Ultrasound features help estimate cancer risk and decide whether repeat imaging or a needle sample is needed.

Thyroid Nodules

Plural form; see *Thyroid Nodule*.

Thyroid Papillary Carcinoma

The most common type of thyroid cancer, arising from cells that make thyroid hormone. It often grows slowly and can spread to nearby lymph nodes; outlook depends on its size, spread, and other tumor features.

Thyroid Peroxidase Antibody

An immune protein directed against thyroid peroxidase, an enzyme needed to make thyroid hormones. A high level supports autoimmune thyroid disease, especially Hashimoto disease, but does not by itself show how well the thyroid is working.

Thyroid Peroxidase Test

A blood test measuring antibodies against thyroid peroxidase, an enzyme needed to make thyroid hormones. Elevated levels support autoimmune thyroid disease but do not by themselves show how well the thyroid is working.

Thyroid Preparation Overdose

Taking too much thyroid hormone medicine can cause a fast or irregular heartbeat, shaking, sweating, anxiety, vomiting, fever, or, in severe cases, heart failure or a dangerous thyroid crisis.

Thyroid Scan

A nuclear-medicine test that shows how actively the thyroid or a thyroid lump takes up a small radioactive tracer. An overactive lump is rarely cancerous; a less-active lump has reduced tracer uptake but is not necessarily malignant.

Thyroid Scintigraphy

Another name for a thyroid scan. It uses a small radioactive tracer to show thyroid activity, lumps, or thyroid tissue in an unusual location; results are interpreted with blood tests and ultrasound.

Thyroid Stimulating Hormone

A hormone released by the pituitary gland that stimulates the thyroid to make thyroid hormones. Blood TSH is commonly used with free thyroxine (T4) to assess thyroid function; results can be misleading in some pituitary disorders or during severe illness.

Alternate Names:
TSH; Thyrotropin

Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone

Alternate name; see *Thyroid Stimulating Hormone*.

Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone Test

A blood test measuring TSH, the pituitary hormone that regulates thyroid hormone production, used as the primary screen for thyroid dysfunction; see *Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone*.

Thyroid Storm

An acute, life-threatening decompensation in a person with thyrotoxicosis, causing severe dysfunction in multiple organ systems. Findings may include fever, a very fast or irregular heartbeat, agitation or confusion, vomiting or diarrhea, and heart failure. It may be precipitated by infection, surgery, trauma, or another acute illness.

Thyroid Storm Diagnostic Criteria

Standardized quantitative clinical scoring criteria (Burch-Wartofsky Point Scale) assessing the likelihood of decompensated, life-threatening thyrotoxicosis based on the severity of thermoregulatory dysfunction, central nervous system effects, cardiovascular tachycardia/arrhythmias, congestive heart failure, and gastrointestinal-hepatic impairment.

Alternate Names:
Burch-Wartofsky Score

Thyroid Storm Following Thyroidectomy

Acute, life-threatening decompensation from thyroid hormone excess after thyroid surgery, usually in a person with inadequately controlled thyrotoxicosis. Fever, marked tachycardia, agitation or delirium, heart failure, vomiting, and shock may occur.

Thyroid Surgery

Operations that remove part or all of the thyroid gland. They may be performed for selected cancers, enlarging or compressive nodules, goiter, hyperthyroidism, or diagnostic uncertainty; the procedure depends on the disease and its extent.

Thyroid Ultrasound

An imaging test using sound waves to examine the thyroid, thyroid lumps, cysts, and nearby lymph nodes. It can identify features that need monitoring or a needle sample but cannot by itself confirm cancer.

Thyrotoxic Myopathy

Muscle weakness caused by an overactive thyroid, usually affecting the hips, thighs, shoulders, and upper arms. Weakness may occur without pain and can improve when thyroid hormone levels return to normal; severe cases can affect swallowing or breathing.

Alternate Names:
Hyperthyroid Myopathy

Thyrotoxicosis

Too much thyroid hormone in the body, whatever the cause. Unlike hyperthyroidism, it can also result from an inflamed thyroid releasing stored hormone or from taking too much thyroid hormone medicine. It may cause weight loss, a fast heartbeat, shaking, sweating, anxiety, diarrhea, or feeling too hot; severe cases can cause serious illness.

Thyrotoxic Periodic Paralysis

Repeated brief attacks of severe muscle weakness caused by an overactive thyroid, often with low blood potassium. Episodes commonly affect the hips and shoulders and may follow rest after exercise or a high-carbohydrate meal.

Thyrotroph Adenoma

A usually noncancerous pituitary tumor arising from cells that make thyroid-stimulating hormone. It may produce too much hormone, causing an overactive thyroid, headaches, or vision problems if it presses on nearby structures.

Thyrotrophin-Releasing Hormone

A hormone made in the hypothalamus, a part of the brain, that tells the pituitary gland to release thyroid-stimulating hormone and prolactin. It helps link brain signals with thyroid activity and some reproductive functions.

Thyrotrophin-Stimulating Hormone

Another name for thyroid-stimulating hormone, a pituitary hormone that tells the thyroid gland to make and release thyroid hormones. Blood levels help assess whether the thyroid is underactive or overactive.

Thyrotropin

Thyroid-stimulating hormone, a pituitary hormone that stimulates thyroid growth and thyroid-hormone production.

Alternate Names:
Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone; TSH

Thyrotropin Alfa

A recombinant form of thyroid-stimulating hormone used to stimulate residual thyroid tissue or differentiated thyroid cancer cells during selected diagnostic or treatment protocols.

Thyroxine

The thyroid hormone T4, which contains four iodine atoms. The thyroid releases it into the blood, and much of it is converted to the more active hormone triiodothyronine (T3).

Alternate Names:
T4; Tetraiodothyronine

Thyroxine-Binding Globulin

A blood protein that carries most thyroid hormones through the bloodstream. Changes in its amount can alter measured total hormone levels without necessarily changing the amount of active, unbound hormone.

TIA

Alternate name; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

Tibia

The larger, weight-bearing bone of the lower leg, extending from the knee to the ankle. It forms part of both joints and is commonly called the shinbone.

Tibial Artery

An artery of the lower leg, chiefly the anterior and posterior tibial arteries, supplying the leg, ankle, and foot and contributing to pedal pulses.

Tibialcrural Artery

Nonstandard, ambiguous term; see *Tibial Artery*.

Tibial Fracture

A break in the tibia, the major weight-bearing bone of the lower leg, often caused by high-energy trauma, twisting injury, or repetitive stress.

Tibialis Anterior Muscle

A muscle along the front of the shin that lifts the front of the foot and helps turn it inward. Weakness can cause foot drop and make walking difficult.

Tibialis Posterior Muscle

A deep muscle behind the shin that points the foot downward, turns it inward, and helps support the foot's arch. Damage or weakness may contribute to pain or a gradually flattened foot.

Tibial Nerve

A large nerve running from the back of the knee down the back of the leg and behind the inner ankle. It controls several leg and foot muscles and carries sensation from parts of the foot.

Tibial Shaft Fractures

Breaks in the middle portion of the shinbone, often caused by a high-energy injury but sometimes by a twist or lower-force event. Pain, swelling, deformity, or inability to bear weight are common. Treatment depends on alignment, skin and muscle damage, and whether the fracture is open.

Tibia Vara

Tibia vara is inward angulation of the upper shinbone causing bowing of the leg, classically associated with Blount disease or other growth disorders.

Tibiofibular Joint

A joint between the tibia and fibula bones of the lower leg. The upper joint allows small movements, while the lower connection helps stabilize the ankle.

Tic

A sudden, rapid, recurrent, non-rhythmic, and stereotyped motor movement or vocalization preceded by an internal premonitory urge that is temporarily relieved following execution of the action. Motor tics encompass simple tics (eye blinking, shoulder shrugging, neck jerking) and complex tics (facial gesturing, touching objects, echopraxia); vocal tics range from simple throat-clearing, grunting, and sniffing to complex echolalia, palilalia, and coprolalia. Tics can be voluntarily suppressed for limited durations and characteristically fluctuate in severity, frequency, and anatomic distribution over time.

Alternate Names:
Tics; Tic Disorder

Ticarcillin

A penicillin antibiotic with activity against many gram-negative bacteria, including Pseudomonas; it is usually given with clavulanate and can cause allergy or electrolyte disturbances.

Tic Disorder

A neurologic condition causing repeated, sudden movements or sounds that are difficult to control, such as blinking, shrugging, throat clearing, or grunting. Tics may be briefly suppressed, often worsen with stress, and vary in severity.

Tic Douloureux

A chronic pain condition characterized by recurrent, sudden, severe, electric shock-like pain in the distribution of the trigeminal nerve (typically V2/V3). See *Trigeminal Neuralgia*.

Tick

A small, blood-feeding ectoparasitic arachnid belonging to the order Ixodida, classified into hard ticks (family Ixodidae, characterized by a dorsal scutum) and soft ticks (family Argasidae). Ticks serve as prominent vectors of human pathogens worldwide, transmitting bacterial infections (Lyme disease [*Borrelia burgdorferi*], Rocky Mountain spotted fever [*Rickettsia rickettsii*], anaplasmosis, ehrlichiosis, tularemia), protozoal infections (babesiosis), and viral encephalitides (tick-borne encephalitis, Colorado tick fever), as well as inducing alpha-gal red meat allergy and neurotoxin-mediated tick paralysis.

Alternate Names:
Ticks; Ixodid Tick

Tick Bite

A skin puncture created when a parasitic tick inserts its barbed hypostome into host dermis to feed on blood. Transmission of tick-borne pathogens requires varying durations of attachment (e.g., typically $> 24 - -36$ hours of attachment for *Borrelia burgdorferi* transmission in Lyme disease). Management entails prompt mechanical removal with fine-tipped tweezers grasping the mouthparts closest to the skin, examination of the bite site for expanding annular rashes (erythema migrans) or local eschars, and post-exposure antibiotic prophylaxis (e.g., single-dose doxycycline for high-risk deer tick bites in endemic Lyme zones).

Alternate Names:
Tick Bites

Tick Bites

Plural form; see *Tick Bite*.

Tick-borne Diseases

Tick-borne diseases are infections or other illnesses transmitted by ticks, including Lyme disease, babesiosis, ehrlichiosis, and some viral diseases. Removing ticks promptly can reduce risk.

Tick-Borne Encephalitis

A viral infection transmitted mainly by ticks that can cause fever, meningitis, encephalitis, or lasting neurological complications.

Tickborne Relapsing Fever

An infection caused by certain *Borrelia* bacteria and spread by soft ticks. It causes repeated episodes of fever, headache, muscle aches, and joint pain separated by periods of feeling better.

Tick Paralysis

Rapidly worsening weakness caused by poison re-

leased by an attached tick. Weakness often starts in the legs and moves upward; breathing can become difficult, but symptoms usually improve after prompt tick removal.

Tick Removal

The process of detaching a tick from the skin. Prompt, careful removal reduces the duration of attachment, which can affect the risk of some tick-borne infections.

Ticks

Plural form; see *Tick*.

Tick Typhus

A rickettsial infection transmitted by ticks, usually causing fever, headache, rash, and sometimes severe systemic illness.

Ticlopidine

An antiplatelet medicine that reduces the blood's ability to form clots. It was used to prevent stroke or heart-related clots in selected people but is now less common because it can cause serious blood-count and bleeding problems.

Tics

Plural form; see *Tic*.

Tidal Volume

The amount of air breathed in or out with one normal breath. It varies with body size, activity, illness, and breathing support and can be measured during lung-function testing.

Tidy Wound

A clean, sharply cut wound with little contamination, crushing, or dead tissue and clearly defined healthy edges. After examination and cleaning, it may often be closed immediately, depending on its depth, location, and age.

Tietze's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Tietze Syndrome*.

Tietze Syndrome

A related but distinct chest-wall disorder causing painful, visible swelling at one or a few upper costochondral or sternocostal joints. It should not be treated as simply another name for costochondritis.

Tigecycline

An antibiotic used in selected serious infections when other treatments are unsuitable. It stops bacteria making proteins and commonly causes nausea and vomiting; it is not appropriate for every type of infection.

Tight Junction

A seal between neighboring lining cells that controls what can pass between them. It helps keep separate the cell surfaces facing the body cavity and the underlying tissue.

Tilorone

Tilorone is a synthetic antiviral and immune-modulating compound used or studied in some countries; evidence and indications vary by setting.

Tilted Disc Syndrome

A congenital appearance in which the optic disc is angled or rotated, often with an unusual shape of nearby retina and blood vessels. Vision may be normal, but some people have visual-field changes or other eye conditions.

Tilt Table Test

A supervised test for unexplained fainting. A person lies secured on a table that is tilted upright while blood pressure, heart rate, and symptoms are recorded to look for fainting caused by abnormal blood-pressure or heart-rate responses.

Tilt Table Testing

A supervised test in which a patient is moved from a lying to an upright or head-up tilt position while blood pressure, heart rate, and symptoms are monitored. It may help evaluate reflex syncope, orthostatic hypotension, or selected autonomic disorders when the diagnosis remains uncertain; it does not replace assessment for cardiac or neurologic causes.

Timed Up-And-Go Test

A functional mobility test measuring the time required to stand from a chair, walk a short distance, turn, return, and sit. Prolonged performance suggests impaired mobility and increased fall risk but must be interpreted with gait, vision, cognition, and environment.

Time In Range

The percentage of continuous glucose-monitoring readings within a specified glucose range, often 70–180 mg/dL for many nonpregnant adults with diabetes. The range and target percentage are individualized and interpreted with time below and above range.

Time Of Death

The actual or estimated time when a person died. After death, investigators may use body temperature, stiffening, settling of blood, decomposition, insect activity, and chemical changes to estimate it, but the estimate has limits.

Time-Of-Flight PET

A PET scanning method that uses the arrival times of detected radiation to better locate where it came from. This can improve image quality and help show disease more clearly.

Timing Of Breastfeeding

The timing and frequency of breastfeeds, usually guided by early hunger cues and effective milk transfer rather than a rigid clock schedule, with special considerations for newborns and preterm infants.

TIMI Risk Score

A clinical score estimating short-term risk in people with unstable angina or a non-ST-elevation heart attack. It uses age, risk factors, known artery disease, recent symptoms, ECG changes, and heart-injury blood tests to help guide treatment; it supports but does not replace clinical judgment.

Alternate Names:
TIMI Score; TIMI Risk Score for UA/NSTEMI; TIMI Score for STEMI

Timolol

Timolol is a non-selective beta blocker used in glaucoma eye drops and for selected cardiovascular conditions; topical ocular use can still cause bradycardia, hypotension, bronchospasm, or fatigue.

Timolol Maleate

The maleate salt of timolol, a beta blocker used in glaucoma and selected cardiovascular conditions.

Timothy Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder affecting the heart and several body systems. It can cause a dangerously prolonged heart rhythm, heart defects, webbed fingers or toes, and developmental or immune problems.

Tinea

A fungal infection of the skin, hair, or nails caused by fungi that feed on a protein called keratin. Common forms include ringworm, athlete's foot, and jock itch.

Tinea Barbae

A fungal infection of the beard or moustache area. It can cause an itchy, scaly rash, inflamed hair follicles, pus-filled spots, or painful lumps and may spread from infected animals or people.

Tinea Capitis

A fungal infection of the scalp and hair, most common in children. It may cause scaling, itching, broken or falling hair, swollen tender areas, or pus-filled sores and usually needs prescription treatment.

Tinea Corporis

A fungal infection of the body skin, often causing an itchy, scaly, ring-shaped rash with a clearer center. It spreads through contact with infected people, animals, or contaminated objects.

Tinea Cruris

Alternate name; see *Jock Itch*.

Tinea Faciei

A fungal infection of the face that can cause a red,

scaly, ring-shaped or uneven rash. It may resemble eczema or rosacea and can spread from infected people, animals, or another infected body area.

Tinea Favosa

A long-lasting fungal infection of the scalp or skin that causes yellow, cup-shaped crusts around hair follicles. It can lead to scarring and permanent hair loss if untreated and is now uncommon in many regions.

Tinea Imbricata

A long-lasting fungal skin infection found mainly in parts of the Pacific and Southeast Asia. It causes overlapping, scaly rings that form a distinctive wood-grain pattern on the body.

Tinea Incognito

A fungal skin infection whose appearance has been changed by using a steroid cream or other immune-suppressing treatment. It may become less scaly but more widespread or unusual, so testing may be needed before targeted treatment.

Tinea Infection

A fungal infection affecting skin, hair, or nails. It may cause a ring-shaped scaly rash, peeling or cracking between the toes, an itchy groin rash, scalp scaling, or thickened discolored nails.

Alternate Names:
Ringworm Infection; Dermatophyte Mycosis

Tinea Manuum

A dermatophyte fungal infection of one or both hands. It may cause dry scaling, redness, itching, thickened skin, or blisters and often occurs with fungal infection of the feet or nails.

Tinea Nigra

A usually harmless fungal infection causing a painless brown or black patch, most often on the palm or sole. It may resemble a mole or skin cancer and can be confirmed with a skin examination or sample.

Tinea Pedis

A fungal infection of the feet, also called athlete's foot. It may cause itching, peeling or cracking between the toes, dry scaling on the soles, blisters, or sores and can spread to the nails.

Tinea Unguium

A fungal infection of the nail plate, also called onychomycosis, causing thickening, discoloration, brittleness, or separation of the nail.

Tinea Versicolor

Alternate name; see *Pityriasis Versicolor*.

Tinel Sign

Tingling or an electric sensation felt along a nerve when the nerve is gently tapped. It may suggest nerve irritation or recovery after injury, but it is not diagnostic by itself.

Tinidazole

Tinidazole is a nitroimidazole antimicrobial effective against anaerobic bacteria and protozoa such as Giardia and Trichomonas; metallic taste, gastrointestinal effects, neuropathy, and an alcohol interaction may occur.

Tinnitus

Hearing or sensing sound, such as ringing, buzzing, or hissing, when no outside sound is present. It may occur with hearing loss, loud-noise exposure, ear problems, some medicines, or other conditions.

Alternate Names:
Ringing in Ears; Tinnitus Aurium

Tinzaparin

A low-molecular-weight heparin anticoagulant used for prevention or treatment of venous thromboembolism; bleeding and heparin-induced thrombocytopenia are important risks.

Tinzaparin Sodium

The sodium salt of tinzaparin, a low-molecular-weight heparin used to prevent or treat venous blood clots; bleeding and heparin-induced thrombocytope-

nia are important risks.

Tiopronin

A thiol-containing medicine used in selected cases of cystinuria to increase urinary cystine solubility; rash, proteinuria, and blood abnormalities may occur.

Tiotropium Bromide

A long-acting inhaled medicine that relaxes airway muscles and keeps the airways open. It is used regularly to control COPD and sometimes asthma; it does not provide immediate relief during a sudden attack.

Tip Lesion Variant FSGS

A distinct histological and clinical subtype of focal segmental glomerulosclerosis (FSGS) characterized by the presence of at least one segmental lesion involving the tubular pole (origin of the proximal tubule) of the glomerular tuft, characterized by foam cells, podocyte hypertrophy, and endocapillary cellularity. Clinically associated with abrupt-onset full nephrotic syndrome, well-preserved baseline renal function, and favorable response to systemic corticosteroid therapy.

Alternate Names:
Glomerular Tip Lesion FSGS; Tip Variant FSGS

TIPS

A procedure that creates a channel inside the liver between veins carrying blood into and out of it. The channel lowers high pressure in the portal vein and may treat repeated variceal bleeding or difficult-to-control abdominal fluid.

TI-RADS

An ultrasound scoring system for thyroid lumps. It uses features such as the lump's composition, shape, edges, and calcifications to estimate cancer risk and help decide whether follow-up or needle sampling is needed.

Tirbanibulin

A topical medicine used in short courses to treat actinic keratoses on the face or scalp; local redness, scaling, or irritation may occur.

Tired

Feeling a lack of energy or physical or mental stamina, which may result from sleep loss, exertion, infection, anemia, endocrine disease, medication, depression, or other illness.

Tiredness

Fatigue or reduced energy and endurance that can be physical, mental, or both; persistent unexplained fatigue warrants assessment for sleep, mood, systemic, medication, and metabolic causes.

Tirofiban

An intravenous medicine that temporarily prevents platelets from sticking together. It is used in selected urgent heart conditions or coronary procedures to reduce clotting, but can cause serious bleeding and requires close monitoring.

Tissue

A group of cells and the supporting material around them that work together for a particular function. Examples include muscle, nerve, bone, connective, and lining tissues.

Tissue Adhesions

Bands of fibrous scar tissue that abnormally connect surfaces or organs, often after surgery, inflammation, infection, or bleeding and potentially causing pain, infertility, or obstruction.

Tissue Banks

Facilities that recover, screen, process, preserve, store, and distribute donated human tissue for transplantation, research, or reconstructive treatment under safety and traceability standards.

Tissue Biopsy

The surgical or needle excision of a tissue specimen from a living organism for microscopic examination by a pathologist; see *Biopsy*.

Tissue Congestion

Accumulation of blood or fluid within tissue because of impaired venous drainage, inflammation, obstruc-

tion, or increased vascular flow, producing swelling, redness, or impaired function.

Tissue Distribution

The movement of a medicine or other substance from the bloodstream into body tissues and organs. How much reaches each tissue depends on blood flow, binding, body composition, and the substance's properties.

Tissue Elastance

How strongly a tissue or organ resists being stretched. In the lungs and chest wall, high elastance means more pressure is needed to expand them, which can make breathing harder.

Tissue Engineering

The use of cells, supportive materials called scaffolds, and biologically active substances to create or repair tissues that restore, maintain, or improve body function.

Tissue Expander

A temporary balloon placed beneath the skin and gradually filled with fluid to stretch the skin. The extra skin can later be used for breast, scalp, burn, or other reconstruction.

Tissue Expansion

Gradual stretching of skin or soft tissue with an implanted or external expander so additional tissue can be created for reconstruction; it usually requires staged treatment and monitoring for infection, pain, or device problems.

Tissue Kallikrein

An enzyme made in several tissues that releases chemical messengers affecting local blood flow, blood-vessel leakiness, pain, and inflammation.

Tissue Membrane

A thin layer of tissue that covers a surface, surrounds an organ, or separates spaces in the body. Its structure and function depend on the type of tissue forming it.

Tissue Plasminogen Activator

A natural blood protein that starts the process of breaking down clots. Manufactured forms are used in selected emergencies, such as some strokes, heart attacks, and lung clots, but can cause serious bleeding.

Tissue Plasminogen Activator-Associated Angioedema

Sudden swelling of the face, lips, tongue, or throat after treatment with a clot-dissolving medicine. Throat swelling can block breathing.

Tissue Transglutaminase

An enzyme found throughout the body. In celiac disease, the immune system may make antibodies against it, so a blood test for these antibodies is commonly used during evaluation.

Tissue Typing

Testing tissue antigens, especially HLA, to assess compatibility for transplantation.

Titanium

A strong, lightweight, corrosion-resistant metal used in implants, prostheses, dental devices, and surgical instruments. Bone can form a stable connection with some titanium implant surfaces.

Titer

A laboratory measure showing how much antibody or another detectable substance is present in a sample. It is often reported as the greatest dilution that still produces a measurable reaction; meaning depends on the test and timing.

Titration

Gradually changing a medicine dose to find the amount that gives the desired effect with acceptable side effects, or measuring a substance by reacting it with a solution of known strength.

Titre

A measure of antibody or another substance's concentration, determined by repeatedly diluting a sam-

ple until detection stops. Titres can help assess infection, immunity, or response, but interpretation depends on the test and timing.

Titubation

A regular, trembling or nodding movement of the head or body. It can occur when the part of the brain that helps control balance and coordination is diseased.

Tizanidine

A medicine that reduces nerve signals causing muscle tightness and spasms. It is used for selected painful spasms or spasticity but can cause sleepiness, dizziness, low blood pressure, dry mouth, and liver problems.

Alternate Names:
Zanaflex; Central Alpha-2 Agonist Muscle Relaxant

T-Lymphocyte

A white blood cell that matures in the thymus and directs cell-based immune responses. Different T cells kill infected cells, coordinate immunity, remember previous threats, or reduce excessive immune activity.

Tmax

The time after a dose when a medicine reaches its highest measured concentration in blood or plasma.

TMD

Alternate name; see *TMJ Disorder*.

TMJ Disorder

A group of musculoskeletal and neuromuscular conditions characterized by pain and dysfunction affecting the temporomandibular joint (TMJ), the muscles of mastication (masseter, temporalis, medial and lateral pterygoids), and associated cranial structures. Classified etiologically into masticatory myofascial pain, internal disc derangements (disc displacement with reduction [causing joint clicking/popping] or without reduction [causing "closed lock" jaw limitation]), and degenerative joint disease (osteoarthritis). Features include preauricular pain exacerbated by chewing or jaw motion, restricted mandibular range of motion, and joint crepitus; management utilizes conservative modalities (occlusal splints, NSAIDs, physical therapy, jaw rest) and arthrocentesis or surgery for refractory articular pathology.

Alternate Names:
TMJ Disorders; Temporomandibular Joint Disorder; TMD

TMJ Disorders

Plural form; see *TMJ Disorder*.

TNBC

Alternate name; see *Triple-Negative Breast Cancer*.

TNF Alpha

A chemical messenger made by immune cells that promotes inflammation. It helps fight infection but excessive or prolonged activity can contribute to autoimmune disease, fever, tissue damage, and some cancers.

TNM Classification

A cancer-staging system in which T describes the size or local extent of the primary tumor, N describes involvement of regional lymph nodes, and M describes distant metastasis. The combined findings estimate disease extent, guide treatment, compare outcomes, and inform prognosis; criteria vary by cancer type and staging edition.

TNM Classification Of Cancer Stages

Alternate name; see *TNM Classification*.

TNM Staging

Alternate name; see *TNM Classification*.

Tobacco

A plant product containing nicotine and many toxic combustion or processing chemicals. Its use causes dependence and increases the risk of cancer, cardiovascular disease, and lung disease.

Tobacco Use

Tobacco use exposes the body to nicotine and toxic

combustion or aerosol chemicals, causing addiction and increased risks of cancer, vascular disease, and lung disease.

Tobramycin

An aminoglycoside antibiotic used for selected serious bacterial infections, including some Gram-negative infections. It can damage the kidneys or hearing and is used with dosing and laboratory monitoring when appropriate.

Tocolysis

Use of medicine to slow contractions for a short time when preterm birth may occur. The delay may allow treatment to help the baby's lungs mature or transfer to a hospital with newborn specialists; it does not usually prevent birth permanently.

Tocolytic Agents

Tocolytic agents suppress uterine contractions temporarily to delay preterm birth, often allowing time for corticosteroids or transfer to specialist care.

Tocolytics

Medicines that temporarily slow contractions before term. They may provide time for corticosteroids, magnesium when indicated, or transfer to specialist care, but their use depends on pregnancy duration, the cause of labor, and risks to the pregnant person or fetus.

Tocolytic Therapy

Medicines used for a short time to slow contractions during threatened preterm birth. The delay may allow time for treatments that improve newborn outcomes or for transfer to a hospital with appropriate neonatal care; they do not usually stop preterm birth permanently.

Tocopherol

A form of vitamin E, a fat-soluble vitamin that helps protect cell membranes. Deficiency is uncommon but may cause nerve problems, muscle weakness, or abnormal red blood cells; excessive supplements can also be harmful.

Toddler Feeding Patterns and Diet

Nutritional and feeding guidance for young children from 6 months to 2 years of age, transitioning from pureed foods to family meals with diverse nutrient-rich textures, iron-rich foods, and healthy mealtime routines.

Alternate Names:
Toddler Nutrition; Weaning and Complementary Feeding; Child Diet 6-24 Months

Toddler's Fracture

A small spiral crack in the lower shinbone of a young child, usually after a minor twist. The child may suddenly limp or refuse to walk, even though there is little swelling or deformity. The first X-ray may look normal; a repeat X-ray after about two weeks may show healing. Treatment commonly uses a supportive boot or cast, based on examination and imaging.

Alternate Names:
Cast-Tibia Fracture; Childhood Spiral Tibial Fracture

Toddler Test Or Procedure Preparation

Preparing a toddler for a test or procedure uses simple explanations, play, distraction, comfort objects, caregiver support, and any required fasting or medicine instructions.

Todd Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Todd Paresis*.

Todd Paresis

A transient, focal neurological deficit (most commonly hemiparesis, monoparesis, hemihypesthesia, or aphasia) that follows a focal motor or secondarily generalized epileptic seizure. Symptoms typically resolve spontaneously within minutes to 36 hours; it is hypothesized to arise from localized neuronal metabolic exhaustion, transient lactic acidosis, or sustained Todd post-ictal inhibition.

Alternate Names:
Todd Paralysis; Post-Ictal Paresis

Toe-Brachial Index

The ratio between blood pressure measured at a toe and in the arm. It helps assess circulation in the legs, especially when stiff ankle arteries make ankle-pressure testing unreliable.

Toe Joint

Any joint connecting the bones of a toe. Toe joints include the metatarsophalangeal and interphalangeal joints; they permit toe movement and may be affected by arthritis, gout, injury, or deformity.

Toenail

A toenail is the hard keratin plate covering the end of a toe and protecting its underlying tissue; injury, fungus, and ingrowth can cause disease.

Toenail Fungus

Alternate name; see *Nail Fungus*.

Toe Pressure

The blood pressure measured in a toe, useful for assessing circulation in the foot. It can remain reliable when ankle arteries are too stiff to compress, as may occur with diabetes or kidney disease.

Toes

The five digits at the end of each foot. The big toe has two bones and helps with balance and push-off; the other toes usually have three bones each. Injury, arthritis, tight shoes, or nerve and muscle problems can cause pain or deformity.

Togaviridae

A family of viruses that includes some mosquito-borne viruses, such as chikungunya and eastern equine encephalitis virus, which can cause fever, rash, joint pain, or brain inflammation.

Togaviridae Infections

Infections caused by viruses in the Togaviridae family. Symptoms vary by virus and may include fever, rash, joint pain, or encephalitis.

Tokophobia

Tokophobia is an intense fear of pregnancy or childbirth that can cause substantial distress or avoidance. Support may include psychological therapy, birth planning, and specialist maternity care.

Tolazamide

An older sulfonylurea diabetes medicine that increases insulin release; hypoglycemia and weight gain can occur, especially in older adults or people with kidney disease.

Tolcapone

A medicine used with levodopa for selected people with Parkinson disease to prolong levodopa's effect. It can cause diarrhea, involuntary movements, confusion, and potentially fatal liver injury, so liver monitoring is required.

Tolerable Upper Intake Level

The highest average daily intake of a nutrient unlikely to cause harm in almost all healthy people. It includes food, drinks, and supplements and is not a recommended amount to consume.

Alternate Names:
UL

Tolerance

A reduced response to a medicine after repeated use, sometimes leading to a need for a different dose to achieve the same effect. It can develop at different rates; tachyphylaxis refers to a rapid decrease in response.

Toll-Like Receptor

A major class of evolutionarily conserved pattern recognition receptors (PRRs) expressed on the surface and endosomal membranes of sentinel innate immune cells (macrophages, dendritic cells, mast cells) and epithelial barriers. TLRs recognize structural pathogen-associated molecular patterns (PAMPs, e.g., TLR4 recognizing gram-negative lipopolysaccharide, TLR2 recognizing peptidoglycan, TLR3 recognizing viral dsRNA, and TLR9 recognizing unmethylated CpG DNA) as well as damage-associated molecular patterns (DAMPs). Downstream sig-

naling through MyD88 or TRIF activates nuclear factor-kappa B (NF-κB) and interferon regulatory factors (IRFs), triggering inflammatory cytokine synthesis and costimulatory molecule expression for adaptive immunity.

Alternate Names:
Toll-Like Receptors; TLR; TLRs

Toll-Like Receptors

Plural form; see *Toll-Like Receptor*.

Tolmetin

A nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug used for pain and arthritis; gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney injury, and cardiovascular events are important risks.

Tolmetin Overdose

Taking too much tolmetin, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory medicine, can cause stomach bleeding, vomiting, kidney injury, drowsiness, seizures, or other serious effects.

Tolnaftate

A topical antifungal medicine used for some dermatophyte infections such as athlete's foot and ringworm; it is not effective for every type of fungal infection.

Tolosa-Hunt Syndrome

A rare neuro-ophthalmic disorder characterized by severe, unremitting, painful unilateral periorbital/retro-orbital pain accompanied by ipsilateral ophthalmoplegia (palsies of cranial nerves III, IV, and VI) and sensory loss in the V1 distribution, caused by idiopathic granulomatous inflammation within the cavernous sinus or superior orbital fissure, exquisitely responsive to systemic corticosteroid therapy.

Alternate Names:
Painful Ophthalmoplegia; Cavernous Sinus Granulomatous Syndrome

Tolterodine Tartrate

Tolterodine tartrate is an antimuscarinic medicine used for overactive bladder and urinary urgency; dry mouth, constipation, and urinary retention can occur.

Toluene

Toluene is a volatile solvent that can irritate tissues and, with substantial inhalation or ingestion, injure the nervous system, liver, kidneys, or heart.

Toluene And Xylene Poisoning

Poisoning from solvents containing toluene or xylene, often through swallowing or inhalation. It can cause dizziness, confusion, abnormal heart rhythms, breathing problems, or organ injury.

Toluene Toxicity

Solvent poisoning from inhalation or ingestion that can cause CNS depression, arrhythmias, renal tubular acidosis, hypokalemia, weakness, and altered mental status. Check electrolytes, acid-base status, renal function, and ECG; remove the exposure and provide supportive care while correcting life-threatening potassium or acid-base abnormalities.

Tolvaptan

A vasopressin V2-receptor antagonist used in selected patients with hyponatremia or autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease; thirst, rapid sodium correction, and liver injury require attention.

Tomogram

A tomogram is an image of a selected cross-sectional layer of the body or another object, produced by tomography such as CT or MRI.

Tomography

Imaging that produces cross-sectional views, or slices, through the body. Computed tomography uses X-rays, while other forms use ultrasound, magnetic fields, or radioactive tracers.

Tomosynthesis

An imaging test that takes several low-dose X-ray pictures from different angles and combines them into thin layers. It is commonly used to examine

breast tissue in three dimensions.

Tomotherapy

Tomotherapy combines CT imaging with rotating, precisely shaped radiation beams to deliver radiation treatment while adjusting for the target and nearby tissues.

Tongue

A muscular organ in the mouth that helps move food, form speech sounds, swallow, and detect taste. Swelling, sores, weakness, numbness, or restricted movement may result from injury, infection, inflammation, nerve disease, or cancer.

Tongue Biopsy

A tongue biopsy removes a small tissue sample from a tongue lesion for microscopic examination of infection, inflammation, precancer, or cancer.

Tongue Carcinoma

Tongue carcinoma is cancer of the tongue, usually squamous-cell cancer, and may cause a persistent sore, lump, pain, or difficulty speaking or swallowing.

Tongue Disease

Any disorder affecting the tongue, such as infection, inflammation, injury, nerve disease, nutritional deficiency, or cancer. Symptoms may include pain, sores, swelling, altered taste, or difficulty speaking or swallowing.

Tongue Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the tongue that may be noncancerous, precancerous, or cancerous. A persistent lump, ulcer, pain, bleeding, numbness, or difficulty speaking or swallowing needs examination and may require biopsy.

Tongue Problems

Changes in the tongue, such as pain, swelling, sores, color change, numbness, or difficulty moving or tasting. Causes include injury, infection, inflammation, nutritional deficiency, and other disease.

Tongue-Tie

A congenital condition characterized by an abnormally short, thick, or tight lingual frenulum that tethers the bottom of the tongue tip to the floor of the mouth, restricting tongue mobility. In infants, it can cause latching difficulty and painful breastfeeding; in older children, it may affect speech articulation, eating, or dental hygiene. Severe restriction may be treated with a simple surgical release (frenotomy).

Alternate Names:
Ankyloglossia; Lingual Frenulum Tethering; Short Lingual Frenulum; Tongue Tie

Tonic-Clonic Seizure

A seizure causing loss of awareness, first with stiffening of the body and then with repeated jerking movements. Sleepiness, confusion, headache, or muscle soreness commonly follows.

Tonicity

The effect of a solution's effective osmotic concentration on the movement of water across a cell membrane. A hypotonic solution tends to make cells swell, a hypertonic solution tends to make them shrink, and an isotonic solution causes little net change in cell volume.

Tonic Neck Reflex

A normal early-infant reflex, sometimes called the fencing posture. When the infant's head turns to one side, the arm on that side straightens and the opposite arm bends. It usually fades by about six months; marked asymmetry may suggest a neurologic problem.

Alternate Names:
Asymmetric Tonic Neck Reflex; ATNR; Fencing Reflex

Tonic Pupil

A pupil that reacts poorly to light but constricts slowly when focusing on something nearby. It often results from injury to nerves controlling the pupil and may occur with other eye or neurologic findings.

Tonic Pupil Syndrome

A pupil that is enlarged or irregular and reacts poorly to light but constricts slowly with near focus, usually because of damage to postganglionic parasympathetic nerves. New pupil asymmetry with headache, drooping eyelid, or neurologic symptoms can indicate a serious neurologic cause.

Tonics

Preparations traditionally claimed to improve strength, energy, appetite, or general health. Their ingredients, safety, and evidence vary widely, and some may interact with medicines or contain harmful amounts of active substances.

Tonic Seizures

Seizures causing sustained stiffening of muscles, usually for seconds to minutes. They may affect one area or the whole body, cause falls or breathing difficulty, and require individualized seizure evaluation.

Tonometer

An instrument that measures pressure inside the eye. Eye-pressure readings help detect glaucoma or monitor treatment, but they must be interpreted with the optic nerve, visual field, cornea, and other findings.

Tonometry

Measurement of pressure inside the eye, usually to assess for glaucoma or monitor its treatment. Methods include applanation, noncontact air-puff, rebound, and electronic devices; results must be interpreted with corneal thickness and the clinical context.

Tonsil

A small mass of immune tissue at the back of the throat. Tonsils help detect germs entering through the mouth and nose but can become enlarged or infected, causing sore throat, difficulty swallowing, or breathing problems.

Alternate Names:
Palatine Tonsil; Tonsilla

Tonsillar Cancer

Cancer arising in a tonsil, most often from the surface lining cells. It may cause a persistent sore throat, pain felt in the ear, trouble swallowing, a tonsil that is larger on one side, or a lump in the neck.

Tonsillar Neoplasm

A tonsillar neoplasm is an abnormal growth in a tonsil that may be benign or malignant and can cause a persistent sore throat, swallowing difficulty, or neck swelling.

Tonsillectomy

Surgery to remove the tonsils for selected recurrent infections, obstructive sleep apnea, or other tonsil disease. Postoperative pain and bleeding can occur; hemorrhage may develop shortly after surgery or during healing and can require urgent treatment.

Tonsillitis

Inflammation or infection of the tonsils, usually caused by a virus and sometimes by group A streptococcal bacteria. It can cause sore throat, fever, swollen neck glands, painful swallowing, and white patches.

Tonsil Stones

Small, hard lumps formed when food particles, mucus, dead cells, and bacteria become trapped and calcify in the folds of the tonsils. They are often harmless but may cause bad breath, throat irritation, a feeling that something is stuck in the throat, recurrent inflammation, or visible white or yellow deposits.

Tonus

The normal resting tension or partial contraction of a muscle or tissue. Abnormally low or high tone can occur with nerve, muscle, brain, spinal-cord, or developmental disorders.

Tooth

A hard mineralized structure anchored in the jaw, used for biting, tearing, chewing, and grinding food.

Tooth Abrasion

Loss of tooth substance caused by external mechanical friction, such as aggressive brushing, abrasive products, or habits, producing grooves, notches, or sensitivity.

Tooth Abscess

A tooth abscess is a localized collection of pus from bacterial infection of the tooth or surrounding tissues, causing pain, swelling, and possible spreading infection.

Toothache

Pain arising from a tooth or nearby gum, ligament, bone, or other supporting tissue. Common causes include decay, infection, cracks, trauma, and gum disease.

Toothaches

Alternate name; see *Toothache*.

Tooth Anatomy

A tooth has a hard outer covering called enamel, a supporting layer called dentin, and a living center called the pulp that contains nerves and blood vessels. The root anchors it in the jaw through surrounding tissues.

Tooth Ankylosis

Fusion of a tooth root to alveolar bone through loss of the periodontal ligament, preventing normal eruption and making the tooth appear infraoccluded as neighboring teeth grow.

Tooth Attrition

Wear of tooth surfaces caused by tooth-to-tooth contact, commonly from chewing, bruxism, or malocclusion, producing flattened cusps and possible sensitivity.

Tooth Avulsion

Complete displacement of a tooth from its socket, usually caused by an injury. The tooth, socket, periodontal ligament, and surrounding tissues may all be damaged; permanent teeth are more commonly affected.

Tooth Brushing

Tooth brushing removes plaque and food from teeth and gums. Brushing twice daily with fluoride toothpaste helps prevent tooth decay and gum disease.

Tooth Calcification

Deposition of mineral that forms and hardens enamel, dentin, cementum, and other tooth structures during development; abnormal timing or amount can affect tooth strength and appearance.

Tooth Component

Tooth components include enamel, dentin, cementum, pulp, and supporting tissues, each contributing to tooth strength, sensation, nutrition, and attachment.

Tooth Crowding

Tooth crowding occurs when teeth lack enough space to align normally, often from tooth size, jaw size, eruption pattern, or retained primary teeth.

Tooth Crown

The tooth crown is the visible portion above the gum, covered mainly by hard enamel and containing underlying dentin and pulp.

Tooth Decay

Alternate name; see *Dental Caries*.

Tooth Discoloration

A change in a tooth's color. Causes include stains, tooth decay, injury, too much fluoride while teeth are forming, some medicines, or problems with the hard outer layer of the tooth. Treatment depends on the cause.

Tooth Disease

Any disorder affecting a tooth, including decay, infection, cracks, developmental defects, or wear. It may cause pain, sensitivity, discoloration, swelling, or difficulty chewing.

Tooth Enamel

Tooth enamel is the highly mineralized outer covering of the crown that protects dentin and pulp from wear, acid, and bacteria.

Tooth Erosion

Tooth erosion is the chemical loss of tooth enamel caused by acids, not by bacteria. Acidic foods, drinks, reflux, and repeated vomiting can contribute to it.

Tooth Eruption

The process by which a developing tooth moves through the gum into the mouth. Baby teeth usually appear from about 6 months to 3 years, and permanent teeth from about 6 years onward; timing varies among individuals.

Tooth Extraction

Removal of a tooth from its socket because of severe decay, infection, periodontal disease, fracture, impaction, orthodontic planning, or another clinical indication.

Tooth Fracture

A crack or break in a tooth caused by injury, biting hard material, decay, grinding, or weakened enamel. It may expose the inner nerve, causing pain, sensitivity, infection, or loss of the tooth.

Tooth Infection

Infection of the tooth, its pulp, or surrounding tissues, commonly caused by untreated decay, cracks, or gum disease. It may cause toothache, sensitivity, swelling, fever, or drainage. Facial swelling, difficulty swallowing or breathing, or spreading infection can indicate deep tissue involvement or airway risk.

Tooth Loss

Tooth loss is absence of a tooth due to decay, gum disease, trauma, developmental absence, or extraction and can affect chewing, speech, and oral health.

Tooth Luxation

Injury that loosens or moves a tooth without completely knocking it out. The tooth may be pushed inward, outward, or sideways, with risk of damage to its blood supply, root, or surrounding tissues.

Toothpaste Overdose

Swallowing too much toothpaste can cause stomach upset, vomiting, or diarrhea. Large amounts of fluoride toothpaste can cause serious salt and calcium disturbances, especially in children.

Tooth Replantation

Replacement of an accidentally displaced or avulsed tooth into its socket, followed by stabilization and dental follow-up.

Tooth Resorption

Breakdown of part of a tooth, usually starting inside the tooth or on its root. It may follow injury, infection, orthodontic treatment, or occur without a known cause and can weaken or destroy the tooth.

Tooth Root

The tooth root anchors a tooth in its socket and contains dentin, cementum, pulp, nerves, and blood vessels beneath the gum.

Tooth Sensibility Testing

Dental tests using cold, heat, electricity, or touch to see whether a tooth's nerve responds. The results do not directly measure blood flow inside the tooth and must be combined with examination and dental imaging.

Tooth Sensitivity

Brief, sharp tooth pain triggered by cold, heat, sweet or sour foods, brushing, or touch. It often happens when the inner layer of a tooth is exposed because the outer layer is worn or the gums have pulled back. Tooth decay or cracks can also cause it.

Tophaceous Gout

Advanced, long-lasting gout in which firm lumps of uric-acid crystals build up in and around joints. These lumps, called tophi, may develop on the toes, fingers, ears, or elbows and damage nearby tissue.

Tophus

A firm lump made of uric-acid crystals that collects in or around a joint or in soft tissue after long-standing gout. Tophi can cause pain, inflammation, skin breakdown, deformity, and damage to bone or cartilage.

Topical

Applied directly to skin or a moist lining, usually to act at the treatment site with limited whole-body exposure.

Topical Antibiotics

Antibiotics applied to the skin to treat selected superficial bacterial infections. The choice and duration depend on the organism, site, extent of infection, resistance patterns, and local guidance. Unnecessary or prolonged use can cause irritation and antimicrobial resistance.

Topical Antifungals

Medicines applied to the skin to treat fungal infections such as athlete's foot, ringworm, or jock itch. The product must match the fungus and body site; irritation or treatment failure can occur.

Topical Calcineurin Inhibitors

Non-steroid creams or ointments that reduce immune inflammation in eczema, especially on the face, eyelids, or skin folds. Burning or itching may occur briefly after application.

Topical Corticosteroid Potency

The strength of a steroid cream, ointment, lotion, or gel used on the skin. Mild products are used for sensitive areas or children, while stronger products may be needed briefly for thick or severe inflammation. Choice depends on the diagnosis, body site, age, duration, and risk of skin thinning or other effects.

Topical Retinoids

Vitamin-A-related medicines applied to the skin for acne and some sun-related skin changes. They help prevent blocked pores and increase skin-cell turnover but may cause dryness, irritation, and increased sun sensitivity; pregnancy precautions vary by product.

Topiramate

An antiseizure medicine also used to prevent migraine. It may cause tingling, slowed thinking, weight loss, kidney stones, or acid imbalance and can harm a developing fetus; abrupt discontinuation can trigger seizures in people with epilepsy.

Topographic Spinal Cord Anatomy

The organization of the spinal cord into segments, gray matter, white-matter tracts, roots, enlargements, and vascular territories. This anatomy explains patterns of motor, sensory, reflex, and autonomic loss after cord injury or disease.

Topoisomerase

An enzyme that temporarily cuts and rejoins DNA to control its twisting during replication, transcription, and chromosome separation.

Topoisomerase Ii

An enzyme that cuts both DNA strands, passes another DNA segment through the break, and rejoins the strands; it is targeted by some anticancer drugs.

Topoisomerase Inhibitors

Drugs that interfere with DNA topoisomerases; some are antibiotics and others are anticancer medicines, with toxicity depending on the drug and target enzyme.

Topotecan

A topoisomerase-I inhibitor used for selected ovarian, small-cell lung, and cervical cancers; bone-marrow suppression is a major toxicity.

Topotecan Hydrochloride

A salt form of topotecan, a chemotherapy medicine that interferes with DNA copying. It treats selected cancers but can cause dangerously low blood counts, infection, bleeding, diarrhea, nausea, or fatigue.

TORCH Panel

A group of blood tests used when pregnancy or new-

born findings suggest infection acquired before birth. TORCH traditionally refers to Toxoplasma, other infections, rubella, cytomegalovirus, and herpes; individual tests and antibody results need careful clinical interpretation.

TORCH Screen

Testing for selected congenital infections—classically Toxoplasma, Other infections, Rubella, Cytomegalovirus, and Herpes—when fetal or newborn findings suggest an in-utero infection; broad panels require careful interpretation.

TORCH Syndrome

A group of congenital infections caused by Toxoplasma, Other infections, Rubella, Cytomegalovirus, and Herpes simplex, which may cause growth restriction, rash, jaundice, eye disease, hearing loss, brain abnormalities, or other newborn problems.

Toremifene

A selective estrogen-receptor modulator used for metastatic breast cancer in postmenopausal women; hot flashes and, rarely, dangerous QT prolongation may occur.

Torn ACL

A torn anterior cruciate ligament is a knee injury commonly caused by sudden pivoting, landing, or contact, producing a pop, swelling, instability, and difficulty changing direction. Rehabilitation, bracing, or reconstruction is selected according to activity, associated injury, and goals.

Torn Meniscus

A torn meniscus is a split in the knee's shock-absorbing cartilage caused by twisting or degeneration. Pain, swelling, catching, or locking may occur; physical therapy or arthroscopic treatment depends on tear pattern, symptoms, age, and associated disease.

Alternate Names:
Meniscal Tear; Torn Semilunar Cartilage

Torn Rotator Cuff

A partial or complete tear of one or more rotator-cuff tendons, causing shoulder pain, weakness, night symptoms, or difficulty lifting or rotating the arm.

Torpor

A state of greatly reduced activity, alertness, or responsiveness. In a patient, marked or new torpor may signal a serious illness, medicine effect, or metabolic problem.

Torsade De Pointes

A dangerous, fast heart rhythm in which the lower chambers beat in a twisting pattern. It is often linked with a prolonged electrical recovery time, abnormal body salts, certain medicines, or inherited heart conditions and can cause collapse or cardiac arrest.

Torsades De Pointes

A dangerous, fast heart rhythm arising from the lower chambers and often associated with a prolonged QT interval. It may cause dizziness, fainting, or cardiac arrest; reversible causes include certain medicines and abnormal body salts.

Torsemide

A water tablet that helps the kidneys remove salt and water. It treats swelling caused by heart, kidney, or liver disease but can cause dehydration, low blood pressure, or abnormal body-salt levels.

Torsion

Twisting of a body structure around its supporting axis, which may reduce or stop blood flow. Torsion of the testicle, ovary, or bowel can cause tissue death if blood flow remains blocked.

Torsion Dystonia

A movement disorder in which repeated or sustained muscle contractions twist part of the body into abnormal postures. It may affect one area or many areas and can be inherited or develop after illness, injury, or medicine exposure.

Torsion of Appendix Testis

Twisting of a small embryonic remnant attached

to the upper part of a testicle, usually in a child. It can cause localized scrotal pain and tenderness; testicular torsion is an important separate diagnosis.

Torsion of Testicular Appendage

Alternate name; see *Torsion of Appendix Testis*.

Torsion Of The Appendix Testis

Alternate name; see *Torsion of Appendix Testis*.

Torticollis

A condition in which the neck muscles pull the head into a tilted or rotated position. It may be present from birth or result from pain, injury, muscle spasm, nerve disease, or another condition.

Torulaspora

A genus of yeasts used in food and fermentation; human infection is rare and usually opportunistic.

Torus Fracture

A stable incomplete break in a child's bone caused by compression, often in the wrist after a fall. The bone bulges rather than breaking all the way through; it usually heals well with a splint or cast and follow-up as advised.

Alternate Names:
Buckle Fracture; Metaphyseal Buckle Fracture

Torus Mandibularis

A harmless, usually painless bony lump on the tongue side of the lower jaw, commonly near the premolar teeth. It usually needs no treatment unless it is repeatedly injured or interferes with dentures.

Torus Palatinus

A harmless, usually painless bony lump along the middle of the roof of the mouth. It grows slowly and usually needs no treatment unless it becomes irritated or interferes with eating or dentures.

Total Abdominal Colectomy

Surgery to remove the entire colon through an abdominal incision or keyhole approach. The small intestine may be joined to the rectum or brought through the abdominal wall as an ileostomy, depending on the disease and safety.

Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Connection

Alternate name; see *Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Return*.

Total Anomalous Pulmonary Venous Return

A birth defect in which the veins returning oxygen-rich blood from the lungs connect to the wrong side of the heart. Babies may have blue skin, rapid breathing, poor feeding, or heart failure. Severe obstruction is an emergency, and surgery is needed to reroute the veins.

Total Artificial Heart

A mechanical device that replaces the pumping function of both ventricles and is used in selected patients with severe biventricular heart failure, usually as a bridge to transplantation. It requires specialized center-based management and carries risks including bleeding, infection, thrombosis, and device malfunction.

Total-Body Skin Examination

A systematic examination of the skin, scalp, nails, and visible mucous membranes from head to toe to look for new, changing, or suspicious lesions. It may include dermoscopy and is especially useful for people at increased risk of skin cancer.

Total Body Surface Area

The percentage of the skin affected by a burn or another widespread process. Clinicians estimate it using the person's palm or body-area charts to judge severity and guide treatment.

Total Breech Extraction

A delivery procedure in which a clinician brings out a breech baby by the feet. It is mainly used for a second twin in selected circumstances, not routinely for a single full-term breech baby because of injury risks.

Total Cholesterol

Total cholesterol is the combined cholesterol carried in major blood lipoproteins; cardiovascular risk is assessed with HDL, LDL, triglycerides, and other factors.

Total Daily Energy Expenditure

The total energy the body uses in one day, including energy needed at rest, digestion, movement, and physical activity. It varies with body size, age, muscle mass, health, and activity level.

Total Haemolytic Complement Test

A blood test that measures whether a group of immune proteins can work together to destroy cells. An abnormal result may suggest immune deficiency, autoimmune disease, infection, inflammation, or a laboratory problem.

Total Hip Arthroplasty

Surgery that replaces a damaged hip joint with artificial parts. It is used for severe arthritis, fractures, or other joint damage when pain and loss of movement continue despite other treatment.

Total Hysterectomy

Removal of the uterus and cervix. The fallopian tubes and ovaries are not necessarily removed and should be specified separately, such as salpingectomy or oophorectomy.

Total Intravenous Anesthesia

General anesthesia given entirely through medicines injected into a vein rather than inhaled gases. It produces controlled unconsciousness during surgery, while trained anesthesia staff continuously monitor breathing, blood pressure, and other vital functions.

Total Iron Binding Capacity

A blood-test estimate of how much iron the protein transferrin can carry. It is interpreted with blood iron, ferritin, blood counts, and other findings to assess iron deficiency, inflammation, or iron overload; it does not measure stored iron directly.

Total Iron-Binding Capacity

A clinical laboratory blood test measuring the maximum concentration of iron that can be bound by circulating serum transferrin molecules, elevated in iron deficiency anemia and decreased in anemia of chronic disease, hemochromatosis, and malnutrition.

Alternate Names:
TIBC

Total Knee Arthroplasty

Surgery that replaces damaged surfaces of the knee with artificial parts to relieve severe pain and improve movement. It may be recommended for advanced arthritis or major joint damage after other measures are inadequate; rehabilitation and monitoring help restore function and detect complications.

Total Knee Replacement

Surgery that replaces damaged surfaces of the knee with artificial parts to relieve severe pain and improve function. Recovery includes exercises and gradual activity; infection, blood clots, stiffness, loosening, persistent pain, or repeat surgery may occur.

Alternate Names:
Total Knee Arthroplasty

Total Laryngectomy

Total laryngectomy removes the entire voice box and creates a permanent opening in the neck for breathing, usually to treat advanced laryngeal cancer.

Total Lesion Glycolysis

A PET-scan measurement combining the amount of active tumor tissue with how much radioactive sugar-like tracer it absorbs. It estimates the tumor's overall activity and may help monitor treatment, but does not determine outlook alone.

Total Lung Capacity

The greatest amount of air the lungs can hold after a full breath in. Lung-volume testing measures it; the amount may be too high when lungs are overinflated or too low when the lungs or chest cannot expand

normally.

Total Pancreatectomy

Total pancreatectomy removes the entire pancreas and causes permanent loss of insulin and digestive-enzyme production, requiring lifelong replacement treatment.

Total Parenteral Nutrition

Nutrition given through a vein when the digestive system cannot absorb enough food. The solution can provide water, sugar, protein, fat, vitamins, and minerals, but requires monitoring for infection, blood-sugar changes, and liver or electrolyte problems.

Total Proctocolectomy And Ileal-Anal Pouch

Total proctocolectomy with an ileal-anal pouch removes the colon and rectum and creates a pouch from the ileum that is connected to the anus.

Total Proctocolectomy With Ileostomy

Total proctocolectomy with ileostomy removes the colon and rectum and diverts the end of the small intestine through an abdominal stoma.

Total Protein

The combined amount of albumin and other proteins in the blood. A blood test may help assess nutrition, liver or kidney disease, inflammation, or abnormal antibody production.

Total Protein Test

A blood test measuring the combined concentration of albumin and globulins to evaluate nutritional status, liver disease, and kidney function; see *Total Protein*.

Total Sleep Time

The total amount of time spent asleep during a defined sleep period or sleep study, excluding periods of wakefulness.

Total Thyroidectomy

The complete surgical resection of both lobes and the isthmus of the thyroid gland, indicated for aggressive thyroid malignancies, compressive multinodular goiters, or medically refractory Graves disease, carrying specific risks of recurrent laryngeal nerve injury and permanent hypoparathyroidism.

Touch

The sensory perception of contact, pressure, texture, vibration, or movement across the skin. Signals travel through sensory nerves to the spinal cord and brain.

Tourette Disorder

Alternate name; see *Tourette Syndrome*.

Tourette's

Alternate name; see *Tourette Syndrome*.

Tourette's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Tourette Syndrome*.

Tourette Syndrome

A neurodevelopmental disorder defined by at least two motor tics and one or more vocal tics, which need not occur together. Tics begin before age 18 and recur for at least one year, without a tic-free interval longer than three months; they are not due to a substance or another medical condition. Tics often wax and wane and change over time.

Alternate Names:
Tourette Disorder; Tourette's Disorder; Gilles de la Tourette Syndrome

Tourniquet

A band or pneumatic device placed around a limb to temporarily occlude or greatly reduce arterial blood flow. Emergency tourniquets are designed for control of severe limb bleeding, while pneumatic surgical tourniquets create a relatively bloodless operative field. Prolonged inflation can cause nerve, muscle, or skin injury.

Tourniquet Test

A bedside test that looks for small skin spots after brief pressure from a blood-pressure cuff. It may show increased capillary fragility or low platelets, but it is not specific and cannot diagnose dengue or another disease by itself.

Alternate Names:
Rumpel-Leede Test; Hess Test; Capillary Fragility Test

Towel Clamp

A surgical clamp with sharp points used to secure drapes or hold materials in place during an operation. Its points can puncture skin or damage underlying tissue.

Townes Syndrome

A rare inherited birth disorder that commonly causes blockage or absence of the anal opening and unusual thumbs. Kidney, heart, hearing, foot, or genital abnormalities may also occur. The specific problems vary, so treatment is planned around each child's findings.

Toxaphene

A persistent organochlorine insecticide mixture that can accumulate in soil, water, and body fat. Significant exposure may overstimulate the nervous system and cause tremors, seizures, liver injury, or other toxic effects.

Toxbase

A clinical poison-information service that helps healthcare professionals assess chemical or medicine exposures. It provides evidence-based advice about expected symptoms, necessary tests, treatment, observation, and urgency for particular substances.

Toxic

Poisonous or capable of harming living cells, tissues, organs, or the whole body. Toxicity depends on the substance, dose, route, duration, and individual susceptibility.

Toxic Adenoma

A benign thyroid nodule that produces thyroid hormone independently of normal pituitary control. It can cause thyrotoxicosis and appears as a functioning nodule on thyroid scintigraphy.

Alternate Names:
Toxic Thyroid Adenoma; Autonomous Thyroid Nodule; Hot Thyroid Nodule

Toxic Anterior Segment Syndrome

A sterile, noninfectious inflammatory reaction in the anterior eye after surgery, caused by toxic substances or contaminants introduced during the procedure. Severe corneal edema, anterior chamber inflammation, and elevated pressure may occur.

Toxic Dose

The amount of a substance that causes harmful effects. It varies with the substance, route, duration of exposure, age, health, and individual susceptibility.

Toxic Effect

Harmful change caused by a chemical, medicine, poison, radiation, or other exposure. The effect may involve one or more organs and depends on the dose, route, duration, metabolism, and individual susceptibility.

Toxic Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction caused by a poison, chemical, or medicine. It may cause confusion, unusual behavior, memory or movement problems, seizures, or reduced alertness; effects depend on the exposure and its duration.

Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis

The most extensive form of the Stevens-Johnson syndrome/toxic epidermal necrolysis spectrum, usually triggered by a medicine. It causes widespread painful skin blistering and detachment with mucosal erosions; epidermal detachment involves more than 30% of body-surface area. Detachment of 10–30% is classified as SJS/TEN overlap.

Alternate Names:
TEN

Toxicity

The ability of a substance, treatment, or exposure to cause harmful effects in a living organism. Severity depends on the dose, route, duration, metabolism, target organs, and individual susceptibility; effects may be temporary or permanent.

Toxicity Grade

A standardized rating of how severe a harmful effect is, often used for adverse effects of medicines or cancer treatment. Grades generally range from mild to life-threatening and help guide monitoring and management.

Toxic Megacolon

A dangerous, rapid widening of the large intestine during severe inflammation or infection. It can cause a swollen, painful belly, fever, a fast heartbeat, or dehydration. The bowel may tear, causing severe infection or shock, so urgent hospital treatment is needed.

Toxic Metabolic Encephalopathy

Temporary or lasting brain dysfunction caused by a poison, medicine, organ failure, infection, or abnormal body chemistry. It may cause confusion, unusual sleepiness, agitation, seizures, or coma; severity depends on the cause and duration.

Toxic Neuropathy

Peripheral-nerve dysfunction caused by a toxic exposure, medicine, metabolic toxin, or substance-use-related injury. Symptoms may include burning pain, numbness, tingling, weakness, or impaired balance.

Toxic Nodular Goiter

An enlarged thyroid containing one or more nodules that make too much thyroid hormone. It can cause weight loss, sweating, shaking, fast or irregular heartbeat, anxiety, or heat intolerance and is assessed with blood tests and imaging.

Toxicodendron Dermatitis

An itchy, often blistering rash caused by skin contact with urushiol, an oil in poison ivy, poison oak, or poison sumac. The rash may appear in streaks where the plant brushed the skin.

Alternate Names:
Urushiol Dermatitis; Rhus Dermatitis; Poison Ivy Rash

Toxicodendron Poisoning

Urushiol-induced allergic contact dermatitis from poison ivy, poison oak, or poison sumac. An intensely itchy, often linear, blistering rash appears after a delay; urushiol can remain on clothing, tools, or animal fur and cause further skin exposure.

Toxicodendron Species

A group of plants that includes poison ivy, poison oak, and poison sumac. Their oil, urushiol, can cause an itchy allergic skin rash after contact.

Alternate Names:
Toxicodendron Plants; Urushiol-Containing Plants; Poison Ivy Oak Sumac Species; Poison Ivy; Poison Oak; Poison Sumac

Toxicokinetic Description

An account of how a harmful substance enters the body, is absorbed, distributed, changed by metabolism, and eliminated. These processes determine the concentration and duration of exposure at target organs.

Toxicology

The study of poisons and harmful effects of chemicals, medicines, and other substances. It includes how exposure happens, how the body is affected, how poisoning is recognized, how it can be prevented, and how it is treated.

Toxicology Screen

A test of urine, blood, or another sample for medicines, drugs, alcohol, or poisons. Results depend on symptoms, timing, and prescribed medicines and may not identify every substance.

Toxicology Specimen Preservation

Collection, labeling, storage, and transport of biological specimens to preserve analytes and prevent contamination or degradation. Appropriate speci-

mens may include peripheral blood, urine, vitreous humor, bile, liver, hair, or gastric contents depending on the suspected exposure and timing.

Toxic Shock Syndrome

A rare, rapidly progressing, and life-threatening condition caused by bacterial toxins, most commonly produced by *Staphylococcus aureus* or group A *Streptococcus* bacteria. These bacterial toxins act as superantigens, triggering an overwhelming immune response that releases massive amounts of inflammatory chemicals into the bloodstream. It classically causes a sudden high fever, dangerously low blood pressure (shock), a widespread sunburn-like skin rash that later peels, confusion, and rapid failure of multiple organ systems.

Alternate Names:
TSS; Staphylococcal Toxic Shock; Streptococcal Toxic Shock Syndrome

Toxic Synovitis

Alternate name; see *Transient Synovitis*.

Toxidrome

A recognizable group of symptoms and examination findings suggesting poisoning by a particular type of substance. Examples include opioid, stimulant, sedative, and cholinergic patterns; the pattern helps guide urgent treatment but does not identify the exact poison by itself.

Toxin

A poisonous substance made by a living organism, such as a bacterium, plant, animal, or fungus. Toxins can damage specific tissues or disrupt nerve, muscle, or cellular functions.

Alternate Names:
Biological Poison

Toxocara

A group of roundworms that live in dogs and cats. People can become infected by swallowing eggs from contaminated soil or food. The young worms can move through the body and sometimes affect organs or eyes, though many infections cause no symptoms.

Toxocara Canis

A dog roundworm whose eggs can infect people. Larvae migrate through tissues and may cause toxocariasis, with fever, cough, enlarged liver, eye inflammation, or rarely nervous-system involvement.

Toxocara Cati

A cat roundworm whose eggs can infect people. The larvae may migrate through organs and cause toxocariasis, including fever, cough, enlarged liver, eye inflammation, or rarely neurologic disease.

Toxocariasis

Infection caused by dog or cat roundworm larvae after a person swallows eggs from contaminated soil, food, or hands. The larvae can migrate through the body and cause fever, cough, enlarged liver, eye inflammation, or rarely brain disease.

Toxoid

A bacterial toxin that has been chemically or otherwise inactivated so it cannot cause its usual harm but can still stimulate protective immunity. Toxoids are used in vaccines against diseases such as tetanus and diphtheria.

Toxoid Vaccines

Vaccines made from bacterial toxins that have been detoxified so they cannot cause their usual harm but can train the immune system to neutralize the toxin. Examples protect against tetanus and diphtheria.

Toxoplasma

A genus of intracellular parasites; Toxoplasma gondii is the species that infects people. Infection is often mild, but it can seriously affect a fetus or people with weakened immunity, especially the brain and eyes.

Toxoplasma Blood Test

A blood test detecting antibodies or genetic material related to Toxoplasma gondii infection, interpreted with symptoms, immune status, pregnancy, and timing of exposure.

Toxoplasma Chorioretinitis

Alternate name; see *Ocular Toxoplasmosis*.

Toxoplasma Gondii

A parasite that causes toxoplasmosis. Cats are its main host and can spread infective forms in their stool; people may also acquire it from undercooked meat, contaminated soil, or contaminated food and water.

Toxoplasma Meningoencephalitis

Inflammation of the brain, and sometimes its coverings, caused by *Toxoplasma gondii*. It occurs mainly in people with severely weakened immune systems and may cause headache, confusion, weakness, seizures, or coma.

Toxoplasmosis

An infection caused by the parasite *Toxoplasma gondii*. People may acquire it from undercooked contaminated meat or shellfish, contaminated soil or food, or cat feces. Most healthy people have no symptoms or mild flu-like illness; infection can seriously affect the eyes or brain in people with weakened immunity and can pass to the fetus after infection during pregnancy. Transmission through an infected organ or blood transfusion is uncommon.

Alternate Names:
Toxoplasma Gondii Infection

Toxoplasmosis Pathology

Tissue injury caused by Toxoplasma gondii, often showing necrotizing inflammation, tachyzoites, tissue cysts containing bradyzoites, and variable lymphohistiocytic or mixed inflammatory infiltrates.

TPA

Tissue plasminogen activator, a natural clot-dissolving protein or a laboratory-made medicine based on it. In selected emergencies it helps break down clots, but it can cause serious bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Tissue Plasminogen Activator; Fibrinolytic Enzyme

TPMT Polymorphism

An inherited difference in the thiopurine methyltransferase enzyme, which breaks down some immune-suppressing medicines. Low enzyme activity can cause dangerously low blood counts unless dosing is reduced or another treatment is chosen.

TPN

TPN, or total parenteral nutrition, supplies nutrients intravenously when the gastrointestinal tract cannot be used adequately.

Trabectedin

A chemotherapy medicine that attaches to DNA and disrupts cancer-cell growth and repair. It is used for selected advanced soft-tissue sarcomas and ovarian cancers and can cause low blood counts, liver injury, nausea, or muscle damage.

Trabecula

A small beam, strut, or partition of tissue, especially within spongy bone. Trabeculae form a supportive internal network that helps bones bear forces while keeping them relatively light.

Trabecular Bone

Light, honeycomb-like bone found inside many bones and near their ends and joints. It supports the body, contains bone marrow, and changes quickly when weight, hormones, medicines, or diseases such as osteoporosis affect bone strength.

Alternate Names:
Spongy Bone; Cancellous Bone

Trabecular Meshwork

A sieve-like tissue near the front of the eye through which the clear fluid called aqueous humor drains. If the drainage pathway becomes blocked, pressure inside the eye may rise and damage the optic nerve in glaucoma.

Trabeculectomy

Glaucoma filtration surgery in which a guarded opening in the sclera allows aqueous humor to drain from the anterior chamber into a filtering bleb be-

neath the conjunctiva, lowering intraocular pressure.

Trabeculoplasty

Laser treatment of the trabecular meshwork that improves aqueous-humor outflow and lowers intraocular pressure, mainly in open-angle glaucoma.

Alternate Names:
Laser Trabeculoplasty

Trace Elements

Minerals needed in very small amounts for normal enzyme function, blood formation, thyroid activity, and other body processes.

Trace Mineral

A mineral needed in very small amounts for health. Examples include iron, zinc, copper, iodine, and selenium; too little or too much can impair blood formation, thyroid function, immunity, growth, or other body processes.

Tracer

A detectable substance used to follow a biological, chemical, or physical process. Medical tracers can show blood flow, organ function, metabolism, or disease location through imaging or laboratory testing.

Trachea

The windpipe connecting the larynx to the right and left main bronchi. Cartilage rings help keep it open so air can move to and from the lungs.

Tracheal Agenesis With Bronchoesophageal Fistula

A very rare birth defect in which the windpipe is absent or severely underdeveloped and an abnormal passage connects the breathing system with the food pipe. Newborns have extreme breathing difficulty and need immediate specialist care.

Tracheal Foreign Body

An object stuck in the windpipe. It can cause choking, noisy breathing, severe breathing difficulty, or complete blockage and is an emergency requiring immediate removal by trained clinicians.

Tracheal Rupture

A tear in the windpipe caused by severe injury, surgery, a medical instrument, or pressure inside the airway. It can let air leak into the chest and cause breathing difficulty, infection, or life-threatening complications.

Tracheal Stenosis

Narrowing of the windpipe, often after prolonged breathing-tube use, tracheostomy, injury, or inflammation. It may cause worsening breathlessness, noisy breathing, or wheezing and can require airway procedures or surgery.

Tracheal Tug

A downward, rhythmic traction or pulling sensation on the cricoid cartilage and trachea synchronized with cardiac systole, felt by placing the examiner's fingers under the cricoid cartilage while the patient extends the neck. It is a physical sign of an aneurysm of the aortic arch downwardly displacing the left main bronchus.

Alternate Names:
Oliver Sign; Cardarelli Sign

Tracheitis

Inflammation or infection of the windpipe. Mild cases may occur with a viral illness, but bacterial infection can rapidly block a child's airway and cause high fever, a harsh cough, noisy breathing, and severe illness.

Trachelectomy

Trachelectomy is surgical removal of the cervix, sometimes with nearby tissue, used in selected cervical cancers or other conditions.

Tracheobronchial Injury

A tear or other damage to the windpipe or a major airway, usually caused by severe chest injury or a medical procedure. It can cause air to leak into tissues around the lungs, breathing difficulty, or a persistent air leak from a chest tube.

Tracheobronchomalacia

Weakness of the windpipe or larger airways that allows them to collapse during breathing. It may cause noisy breathing, chronic cough, repeated infections, or difficulty clearing mucus and may be present from birth or develop later.

Tracheobronchomegaly

Unusual widening of the windpipe and the main airways, usually because their supporting tissue is weak. It can cause a weak cough, breathlessness, repeated chest infections, and difficulty clearing mucus.

Tracheoesophageal Fistula

An abnormal opening between the windpipe and food pipe, usually present from birth. It can let milk enter the lungs, causing coughing, choking, blue coloring, repeated chest infections, or poor growth, and usually needs surgery.

Tracheoesophageal Fistula And Esophageal Atresia Repair

Surgery in a newborn to close an abnormal connection between the windpipe and food pipe and join separated parts of the food pipe when possible. The operation is urgent; breathing problems, leakage, narrowing, reflux, and feeding difficulties may persist.

Tracheomalacia

Weakness of the windpipe wall that allows it to narrow or collapse during breathing out. It may cause noisy breathing, cough, breathlessness, repeated infections, or difficulty clearing mucus and may be present from birth or develop later.

Tracheostomy

A surgically created opening in the front of the neck into the windpipe, usually kept open with a tube. It provides an airway, can bypass an upper-airway blockage, and may allow suctioning or long-term breathing support. It may be temporary or permanent and requires regular care to keep the airway clear.

Alternate Names:
Trach; Surgical Stoma of the Trachea; Tracheostomy Stoma

Tracheostomy Care

Care of a breathing tube and neck opening, including cleaning the skin and tube, suctioning mucus when needed, checking airflow, and keeping emergency equipment nearby. Blockage, bleeding, infection, or accidental tube displacement can obstruct breathing or cause serious injury.

Tracheostomy Tube

A tube inserted through a tracheostomy opening to maintain access to the airway and permit breathing, suction, or mechanical ventilation.

Tracheotomy

A surgical procedure in which an incision (cut) is made through the skin of the neck into the windpipe (trachea) to create a direct airway. It is performed in planned or emergency situations to overcome acute upper-airway obstruction (from foreign bodies, severe infections, or head and neck trauma) or to facilitate prolonged breathing machine support. While "tracheotomy" refers to the surgical act of making the incision into the trachea, the resulting opening and airway passage created by the operation is called a tracheostomy.

Alternate Names:
Tracheal Incision; Surgical Airway Procedure

Trachoma

A chronic eye infection caused by certain types of *Chlamydia trachomatis*. It spreads through contact with infected eye or nose discharge, contaminated items, or, in some areas, flies. Repeated infections can scar the inside of the eyelid, turn the eyelid inward, and cause the eyelashes to rub against the eye. This can scar the cornea and lead to permanent visual impairment or blindness.

Trachyonychia

Rough, thin, ridged nails with many tiny pits, sometimes called twenty-nail dystrophy when most or all nails are affected. It may occur on its own or with psoriasis, alopecia areata, eczema, or lichen planus.

Traction

A controlled pulling force used to align or immobilize a fracture, reduce a dislocation, or relieve pressure on tissues. It may be applied manually, with weights, or through a medical device.

Traction Alopecia

Hair loss caused by repeated pulling on the hair, often from tight braids, ponytails, extensions, or head coverings. Early hair loss may improve when the pulling stops, but long-term tension can permanently scar hair follicles.

Tractional Retinal Detachment

Separation of the light-sensing retina from the back of the eye when bands of scar tissue pull it away. It commonly occurs in advanced diabetic eye disease and can cause vision loss.

Tractotomy

Surgery that cuts a selected nerve pathway in the brain or spinal cord, usually to reduce severe pain or another difficult neurologic symptom. It can cause permanent changes in sensation or movement.

Traditional Medicine

Health practices, remedies, and healing systems developed within cultural traditions. Products and practices vary in evidence, safety, and possible interactions with other treatments.

Tra Gene

A gene involved in sex determination and sexual differentiation in some organisms, especially insects; its function and sequence vary by species.

Trained Immunity

A lasting change in the body's first-line immune response after an earlier infection or exposure. The later response may be stronger or altered, although this process does not provide the same specific protection as ordinary immune memory.

Train-Of-Four Monitoring

A test used during anesthesia that gives four brief electrical signals to a nerve and measures the muscle responses. It shows how much a muscle-relaxing medicine remains active and whether muscle strength has recovered.

Trajectory

The path a projectile follows in flight and, in wound ballistics, the course it traverses through tissue from entrance to exit or rest. Internal trajectory is reconstructed from entrance and exit defects, the organ track, recovered fragments, and clothing damage; angles disclose shooter position and victim posture.

TRALI

A rare, life-threatening lung reaction that develops during or within several hours after a blood transfusion. It causes sudden breathing difficulty and low blood oxygen from fluid leaking into the lungs, without being caused by excess fluid in the circulation.

Tram-Track Appearance

A double-line pattern seen under a microscope in some kidney biopsies. It reflects thickening or splitting of the kidney's filtering membranes and can occur in certain types of glomerulonephritis.

Trance

An altered state of awareness with unusual attention, responsiveness, or sense of surroundings. It may occur during hypnosis, seizures, intoxication, sleep-related events, or psychological states.

Tranexamic Acid

A medicine that helps control bleeding by preventing the body from breaking down blood clots too quickly. It is used for selected heavy bleeding, including some surgical, injury-related, menstrual, and postpartum bleeding.

Transabdominal Cerclage

Placement of a strong band around the upper cervix through abdominal surgery, usually before pregnancy or early in pregnancy, to reduce the risk of premature opening in severe cervical weakness. It requires cesarean birth and carries surgical, bleeding,

infection, and pregnancy risks.

Alternate Names:
TAC; Cervico-Isthmic Cerclage

Transabdominal Pelvic Ultrasound

A non-invasive diagnostic ultrasound examination of the pelvic organs (uterus, endometrium, ovaries, fallopian tubes, and urinary bladder) performed transabdominally through a full acoustic bladder window.

Alternate Names:
Transabdominal Pelvic Sonography; TA Pelvic Ultrasound; Transabdominal Pelvic Scan

Transabdominal Scan

An ultrasound scan performed by moving the probe over the abdomen. It can examine pelvic organs and, during pregnancy, assess the baby's growth and anatomy, the placenta, and the amount of fluid around the baby.

Transaminitis

Higher-than-normal levels of liver-related enzymes in the blood. This may indicate liver-cell injury, but the result does not identify the cause; medicines, infection, alcohol, fatty liver, and muscle injury can contribute.

Transarterial Chemoembolization

A treatment in which a catheter delivers chemotherapy and blocks blood flow to a liver tumor. It can slow or shrink selected tumors that cannot be removed surgically, but may cause pain, fever, liver injury, or other complications.

Transbronchial Biopsy

Removal of a small lung-tissue sample using a camera passed through the airways. It can investigate infection, inflammation, cancer, or rejection after transplant; bleeding and a collapsed lung are possible complications.

Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement

A procedure in which a collapsible replacement valve is delivered by catheter, usually through an artery in the groin, and expanded within the diseased aortic valve without removing it. It treats selected cases of severe aortic stenosis and, with a dedicated device, severe native aortic regurgitation; it can also replace a failing tissue valve. Complications include bleeding, stroke, blood-vessel injury, heart-rhythm problems, or leakage around the new valve.

Alternate Names:
TAVR; TAVI; Transcatheter Aortic Valve Implantation

Transcatheter Edge-To-Edge Repair

A catheter procedure that joins parts of the mitral-valve leaflets to reduce leakage. It may help selected people with severe symptoms who are not good candidates for open surgery; bleeding, infection, stroke, valve narrowing, residual leakage, or device problems are possible.

Alternate Names:
TEER

Transcatheter Intervention

A minimally invasive procedure performed through a catheter inserted into a blood vessel or body passage, including angioplasty, stent placement, valve procedures, and selected structural-heart interventions.

Transcatheter Pulmonary Valve

Replacement of a diseased pulmonary valve with a prosthetic valve delivered through a catheter. It is used in selected congenital or previously operated right-ventricular outflow tracts.

Transcervical Foley Catheter For Cervical Ripening

A soft balloon catheter placed through the cervix and inflated to help soften and open the cervix before labor induction. It is a mechanical method and may cause cramping, bleeding, infection, or accidental rupture of the membranes.

Transcervical Resection Of Endometrium

A camera-guided procedure through the cervix that removes or destroys the uterine lining to reduce heavy menstrual bleeding. It is not suitable for

people who want to become pregnant later.

Transcranial Doppler

An ultrasound test that measures blood-flow speed in arteries inside the skull. It can help detect narrowed vessels, spasm after brain bleeding, or increased stroke risk in selected conditions.

Transcranial Doppler Scanning

An ultrasound test measuring blood-flow speed and direction in major arteries inside the skull. It can help assess narrowing, blockage, vasospasm, emboli, or circulation after certain brain injuries.

Alternate Names:
Transcranial Doppler; TCD

Transcranial Doppler Ultrasound

An ultrasound test that measures blood-flow speed and direction in major arteries inside the skull. It can help assess stroke risk, vessel narrowing, bleeding-related spasm, and blood flow changes.

Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation

A noninvasive treatment or brain-function test that uses magnetic pulses near the scalp to induce electrical activity in selected brain regions. Repetitive stimulation is used for some depression and other conditions; effects and risks depend on the protocol and person's health.

Transcription

The process by which a cell copies information from DNA into RNA. The RNA copy can direct protein production or help control cell activity.

Transcription Factor

A protein that attaches to DNA and increases or decreases the copying of selected genes into RNA. Transcription factors help control cell growth, development, specialization, and responses to hormones or injury.

Transcutaneous Electrical Nerve Stimulation

TENS: low-voltage electrical pulses delivered through electrodes on the skin to reduce pain for some people. It does not treat every cause of pain, and its effect varies by condition.

Alternate Names:
TENS

Transdermal

Delivering a medicine through the skin, usually with a patch or gel, so it enters the bloodstream gradually. The medicine, dose, skin condition, heat, and application site affect how much is absorbed.

Transesophageal Echocardiography

An ultrasound scan of the heart made with a probe passed into the esophagus. It gives close views of the heart, valves, and nearby blood vessels.

Trans Fat

An unsaturated fat containing at least one trans-configured double bond. Industrial trans fats, formerly common in partially hydrogenated oils, can raise LDL cholesterol, lower HDL cholesterol, and increase cardiovascular risk; small amounts also occur naturally in some meat and dairy foods.

Trans Fatty Acid

An unsaturated fat with at least one trans-shaped double bond. Industrial trans fats can raise heart-disease risk; small amounts also occur naturally in some meat and dairy foods.

Alternate Names:
Trans Fat

Transferase

An enzyme that moves a chemical group from one molecule to another. Transferases help cells make and break down substances, and some transferase levels in blood help identify tissue injury or disease.

Transference

Feelings or expectations that a patient developed in an earlier important relationship and now directs toward a therapist or another healthcare professional. Discussing this pattern can help explain relationship difficulties during therapy.

Transferrin

A blood protein made mainly by the liver that carries iron to tissues. Its level and the amount of iron it carries help assess iron deficiency, inflammation, and iron overload when interpreted with other blood tests.

Transferrin Saturation

The percentage of transferrin's iron-binding sites occupied by iron. It is calculated from iron and total iron-binding capacity and helps evaluate iron deficiency and iron overload.

Alternate Names:
TSAT

Transferrin Saturation Test

A calculated percentage reflecting the proportion of transferrin iron-binding sites occupied by circulating iron; see *Transferrin Saturation* and *Iron Studies*.

Transfer Training

Teaching a person how to move safely between places, such as from a bed to a chair or toilet. Training may include correct body position, assistance from another person, a transfer board, or lifting equipment.

Transforming Growth Factor-Beta

A multifunctional cytokine superfamily that orchestrates wound healing, extracellular matrix synthesis, collagen deposition, tissue fibrosis, cell cycle arrest, and immunosuppression by inhibiting epithelial and lymphocyte proliferation while stimulating myofibroblasts.

Alternate Names:
TGF-beta

Transfusion

Delivery of donated blood or blood components into a person's bloodstream. It can replace lost red cells, platelets, or clotting factors but carries risks including reactions, infection, fluid overload, and lung injury.

Transfusion Of Neonate

Administration of a blood product to a newborn for clinically significant anemia, bleeding, or another specific indication. The decision, product characteristics, volume, and rate depend on the infant's symptoms, laboratory results, gestational age, and local transfusion protocol.

Transfusion Reaction

A harmful response to donated blood or blood components. It may cause fever, chills, rash, breathing difficulty, pain, low blood pressure, or destruction of red cells; severe reactions can cause shock or organ injury.

Transfusion-Related Acute Lung Injury

A serious lung reaction that causes sudden breathing difficulty and low blood oxygen during or within six hours after a blood transfusion. It results from fluid leaking into the lungs and is not caused by heart failure or fluid overload; antibodies may contribute in some cases.

Alternate Names:
TRALI

Transient

Lasting for a limited time rather than persisting. In clinical descriptions, the duration depends on the condition and context.

Transient Acantholytic Dermatosis

A recurrent itchy papular rash caused by temporary loss of cohesion between skin cells. It often affects the trunk of older adults and may be triggered by heat, sweating, sunlight, medicines, or illness.

Alternate Names:
Grover Disease

Transient Acantholytic Dermatosis (Grover Disease)

Alternate name; see *Transient Acantholytic Dermatosis*.

Transient Familial Hyperbilirubinemia

An inherited tendency for bilirubin, a yellow waste

product, to rise temporarily in the blood and cause episodes of jaundice. It usually reflects slower processing by the liver without major liver injury and may worsen during illness, fasting, or stress.

Transient Global Amnesia

A sudden temporary inability to form new memories, often with repeated questions and uncertainty about recent events. The person remains awake and knows who they are; symptoms usually resolve within 24 hours. Stroke and seizure can cause similar symptoms.

Alternate Names:
TGA; Acute Amnestic Syndrome

Transient Hypogammaglobulinemia Of Infancy

A temporary delay in an infant's production of antibodies, the proteins that help fight infection. Some infants have repeated ear, sinus, or chest infections, but antibody levels usually improve as the immune system matures.

Alternate Names:
THI; Transient Infantile Hypogammaglobulinemia

Transient Ischaemic Attack

Alternate spelling; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

Transient Ischaemic Attacks Or Episodes

Alternate wording; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

Transient Ischemic Attack

A brief episode of stroke-like symptoms caused by reduced blood flow to the brain, spinal cord, or retina, without acute tissue injury. Symptoms often clear, but a TIA is a warning sign of increased stroke risk.

Alternate Names:
TIA

Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA)

Alternate name; see *Transient Ischemic Attack*.

Transient Neonatal Pustular Melanosis

A harmless newborn eruption in which superficial pustules rupture and leave small pigmented macules with a collarette of scale. It is more common in infants with darker skin and usually resolves without treatment.

Transient Pain

Pain that is brief and resolves rather than continuing or recurring persistently. Severe, recurrent, or associated symptoms may indicate an underlying condition.

Transient Synovitis

A temporary inflammation of the hip joint, usually in children and sometimes following a viral illness. It causes hip, groin, thigh, or knee pain and a limp; fever and severe illness are uncommon, so septic arthritis is an important alternative diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Irritable Hip; Transient Synovitis of the Hip

Transient Tachypnea Of The Newborn

Temporary rapid breathing after birth, usually caused by delayed clearance of fetal lung fluid. It is more common after caesarean birth and typically improves within one to three days with supportive care.

Transillumination

Transillumination shines light through a body part or structure to reveal fluid, cavities, or other differences in tissue density.

Transitional Care

Coordinated healthcare when a person moves between settings or levels of care, such as from hospital to home or from children's to adult services. It includes sharing information, arranging medicines and follow-up, and preventing avoidable complications.

Transitional Epithelium

A stretchable protective lining in the kidneys' drainage areas, ureters, bladder, and part of the urethra. It allows these organs to expand as urine collects without allowing urine to leak into surrounding tissue.

Alternate Names:
Urothelium; Transitional Urothelial Lining

Transjugular Intrahepatic Portosystemic Shunt

A channel created through the liver between veins that bring blood to it and veins that carry blood away. It lowers high pressure caused by advanced liver disease and can reduce repeated bleeding or severe abdominal fluid buildup; confusion and shunt blockage are possible.

Alternate Names:
TIPS; Transjugular Portosystemic Shunt

Translation

The cellular process of making a protein from instructions carried by messenger RNA. A ribosome reads the message in order, while transfer molecules bring the matching amino acids. The process starts, builds the chain, and stops at a signal; the finished chain folds into a working protein.

Translation Initiation

The first stage of protein synthesis, when a ribosome recognizes messenger RNA, selects the start codon, and assembles the initiator transfer RNA and ribosomal subunits.

Translocation

Movement from one place to another. In genetics, it means that a piece of one chromosome moves to another chromosome or location, which can alter genes and sometimes cause cancer or inherited disease.

Transmembrane Transport

Movement of salts, nutrients, medicines, or other substances across a cell's outer membrane. Channels and carrier proteins may allow passage directly, while pumps use energy to move substances against a concentration difference.

Transmission

Passage of an infection, signal, genetic trait, force, or substance from one source to another; in infectious disease, route, dose, and host susceptibility determine risk.

Transmural Infarction

A heart attack that damages the full thickness of part of the heart muscle because blood flow has been blocked for a prolonged period. It can weaken the heart and cause dangerous complications.

Transplacental

Passing from the pregnant person's blood across the placenta to the fetus, or in the opposite direction. Antibodies, medicines, chemicals, and some infections can cross the placenta, with effects that depend on the substance and timing.

Transplant

Transfer of cells, tissue, or an organ from one site or person to another to replace damaged tissue or restore function. Donor matching, rejection prevention, infection risk, and long-term follow-up depend on the type of transplant.

Transplantation

Transfer of an organ, tissue, or cells from a donor to a recipient to replace or restore failing function. Care includes donor matching, surgery, prevention of rejection, infection monitoring, and long-term follow-up.

Alternate Names:
Organ Transplant

Transplantation Conditioning

Treatment given before some stem-cell transplants to suppress the recipient's bone marrow and immune system and make room for donated cells. It may use chemotherapy, radiation, or both and can cause infection, bleeding, infertility, or organ injury.

Transplant Immunology

The study of how the immune system reacts to donated organs, tissues, or cells. Blood-group and tissue matching, antibody testing, and immunosuppressive medicines help reduce rejection, but they also increase infection risk and require regular monitoring of the transplant and medicine effects.

Transplant Rejection

An immune response in which the recipient's immune system recognizes a transplanted organ or tissue (graft) as foreign and injures it. Rejection may be antibody-mediated, T-cell-mediated, or both, and is classified as hyperacute, acute, or chronic. It differs from graft-versus-host disease, in which donor immune cells attack the recipient.

Transplant Surgery

The surgical specialty that retrieves donor organs and performs operations to transplant organs or tissues into recipients. It includes organ-specific procedures and surgical care related to the transplanted organ, in coordination with other medical specialties.

Transport

Movement of a substance, cell, signal, or person from one place to another. In healthcare, the term may describe movement through the body, across a cell membrane, or safe transfer between care settings.

Transport Protein

A protein that carries a substance through body fluids or across a cell boundary. It helps control how nutrients, medicines, salts, and waste products are absorbed, distributed, and used.

Transport Vesicle

A transport vesicle is a membrane-bound carrier that moves proteins, lipids, or other cargo between cellular compartments.

Transposition Of Great Vessels

Alternate name; see *Transposition Of The Great Arteries*.

Transposition Of The Great Arteries

A heart defect present at birth in which the two main arteries are connected to the wrong lower chambers. Blood returning to the body may not receive oxygen; newborns develop severe cyanosis without a pathway for blood to mix.

Alternate Names:
Complete TGA; D-TGA; Transposition of Great Vessels

Transposition of the Great Vessels

Alternate name; see *Transposition Of The Great Arteries*.

Alternate Names:
TGA; D-Transposition of the Great Arteries; d-TGA

Transposons

Movable pieces of genetic material that can shift between locations in a cell's DNA. In bacteria, they may carry antibiotic-resistance genes and help resistance spread between bacteria.

Transrectal Ultrasonography

Ultrasound imaging of the prostate and nearby structures using a probe placed in the rectum. It can guide biopsies and assess size or abnormalities, but may cause discomfort, bleeding, or infection.

Alternate Names:
TRUS

Transsphenoidal Hypophysectomy

A minimally invasive skull-base neurosurgical procedure performed to remove pituitary gland tumors (pituitary adenomas) or craniopharyngiomas located at the base of the brain. Instead of cutting open the skull or leaving visible facial scars, the surgical team passes high-definition endoscopes and microinstruments directly through the patient's nostrils, across the nasal cavity, and through the sphenoid sinus bone into the sella turcica—the bony saddle cradling the pituitary gland. By operating from below, neurosurgeons and otolaryngologists can decompress the optic chiasm to restore threatened vision, normalize excessive hormone production (such as in Cushing disease or acromegaly), and remove tumors with faster recovery times, minimal brain retraction, and reduced complication rates compared to traditional open craniotomies.

Alternate Names:
Endoscopic Transsphenoidal Pituitary Resection

Transthoracic Echocardiogram

A non-invasive point-of-care or formal diagnostic ultrasound procedure utilizing a transducer placed on the anterior chest wall to evaluate cardiac chamber dimensions, ventricular systolic and diastolic function, valvular morphology, and hemodynamics via Doppler imaging.

Alternate Names:
TTE

Transthoracic Echocardiography

An ultrasound scan of the heart made with a probe placed on the chest. It shows the heart chambers, valves, pumping movement, and blood flow.

Transthyretin Amyloidosis

A disease in which abnormal transthyretin protein builds up in organs, especially the heart or nerves. It may be inherited or develop with age without an inherited gene change.

Alternate Names:
ATTR Amyloidosis; Amyloid Transthyretin Disease

Transthyretin Familial Amyloid Polyneuropathy

An inherited transthyretin amyloidosis in which abnormal protein deposits damage peripheral and autonomic nerves. It may cause progressive numbness, pain, weakness, blood-pressure or heart-rate changes, gastrointestinal symptoms, and sometimes heart disease.

Transthyretin p.Val50Met Amyloidosis

Hereditary transthyretin amyloidosis caused by the p.Val50Met variant in the TTR gene. It often causes progressive peripheral and autonomic neuropathy and may also affect the heart; older literature calls the variant Val30Met.

Alternate Names:
Transthyretin Methionine-30 Amyloidosis (Type I); TTR p.Val50Met Amyloidosis

Transtracheal

Transtracheal means passing through or relating to the trachea, such as a catheter, oxygen delivery route, or diagnostic procedure.

Transtympanic

Transtympanic means passing through the tympanic membrane, such as medicine delivered into the middle ear or a procedure crossing the eardrum.

Transudate

A thin fluid with little protein that leaks from blood vessels because of pressure or blood-protein changes rather than inflammation. It may collect around organs, such as the lungs, heart, or abdomen.

Transudation

Movement of relatively watery, low-protein fluid out of blood vessels when pressure or blood-protein levels change. This process can cause some types of swelling or fluid collection around organs.

Transudative Pleural Effusion

A buildup of relatively thin fluid around a lung caused by changes in blood pressure or protein balance, most often heart failure. Treatment focuses on the underlying condition and drainage may be needed if breathing is affected.

Transurethral

Performed through the urethra, the tube that carries urine out of the body. Instruments passed through it can examine the urinary tract, remove tissue, treat blockage, or place a device.

Transurethral Incision Of The Prostate

An operation making small cuts in the prostate through an instrument passed in the urethra. It can improve urine flow in selected people with prostate enlargement while preserving most prostate tissue.

Alternate Names:
TUIP

Transurethral Microwave Thermotherapy

A treatment for some people with an enlarged prostate in which a catheter uses microwave heat to shrink or destroy prostate tissue blocking urine flow. It is less commonly used now and can cause pain,

bleeding, infection, or temporary urinary problems.

Alternate Names:
TUMT

Transurethral Needle Ablation

A treatment using needles passed through the urethra to deliver radiofrequency heat into enlarged prostate tissue. The heat destroys selected tissue and may improve urine flow, but relief develops gradually and complications can occur.

Alternate Names:
TUNA

Transurethral Resection

Removal of tissue through an instrument passed along the urethra, commonly for prostate or bladder disease.

Transurethral Resection of Bladder Tumor

A procedure in which a urologist passes a camera and small cutting tool through the urethra to remove a visible bladder tumor and collect tissue for testing. The results show the type and depth of the cancer and guide further treatment. Some early tumors are treated during the same procedure, but follow-up treatment may still be needed.

Alternate Names:
TURBT; Transurethral Bladder Tumor Resection; Bladder Tumor Resection

Transurethral Resection Of The Prostate

An endoscopic operation that removes obstructing prostate tissue to improve urine flow in selected people with benign prostatic enlargement. Alternatives and indications depend on symptoms, prostate size, complications, and patient preference.

Alternate Names:
TURP; Transurethral Prostate Resection

Transvaginal

Performed through the vagina, commonly describing an ultrasound examination or a procedure involving the uterus, cervix, ovaries, or other pelvic structures.

Transvaginal Ultrasound

Transvaginal ultrasound uses a covered probe in the vagina to produce images of the uterus, ovaries, cervix, pregnancy, or nearby pelvic structures.

Transverse

Running across or perpendicular to the long axis or midline.

Transverse Colon

The section of the large intestine that crosses the upper abdomen from the right side to the left. It absorbs water and moves partly digested food toward the descending colon.

Transverse Lie

A position in which the baby lies sideways across the uterus rather than head-down or bottom-down. A shoulder or arm may be closest to the birth canal; if the position persists near labor, vaginal birth is usually not possible.

Transverse Myelitis

Inflammation across part of the spinal cord that can develop over hours or days and cause weakness, numbness, pain, or problems controlling the bladder or bowel. Delayed treatment can increase the risk of lasting disability.

Transverse Plane

An imaginary horizontal slice that divides the body or an organ into upper and lower parts. Medical scans often use this view to show structures at a particular level.

Transverse Vaginal Septum

A congenital band of tissue crossing the vagina and partly or completely blocking it. A complete blockage can cause absent periods and monthly pelvic pain after puberty; imaging confirms the condition, and surgery may create an open vaginal passage.

Transversus Abdominis Muscle

The deepest broad muscle of the abdominal wall. It tightens the abdomen, supports the spine, and

helps with coughing, breathing out, lifting, and other movements that increase pressure inside the abdomen.

Transvestic Disorder

A mental-health diagnosis involving repeated sexual arousal from cross-dressing that causes significant distress, interferes with life, causes harm, or involves another person without consent. Cross-dressing alone is not a disorder and is different from gender identity.

Tranylcypromine

An antidepressant that increases certain brain chemicals by blocking their breakdown. It can interact dangerously with many medicines and foods high in tyramine, so careful prescribing and a medicine-free waiting period before or after some treatments are required.

Trapezium Bone

A small wrist bone at the base of the thumb. It forms the thumb's highly mobile joint with the hand and can be affected by fractures or arthritis that causes pain during gripping and pinching.

Trapezius Muscle

A large triangular muscle across the upper back and neck. It helps lift, lower, and draw the shoulder blades backward and supports movement and stability of the neck and shoulders.

Trapezoid

A small wedge-shaped wrist bone between the trapezium and capitate. It joins mainly with the index-finger metacarpal and helps stabilize the thumb-side of the wrist; fractures are uncommon.

Trapezoid Bone

A small distal-row carpal bone between the trapezium and capitate that articulates mainly with the index metacarpal and helps stabilize the radial side of the hand.

Trapped Lung

A condition in which a lung cannot fully expand because a fibrous layer or another restriction prevents normal movement. It may follow long-standing pleural inflammation, infection, bleeding, or cancer and can cause persistent pleural fluid or breathlessness.

TRAP Sequence

A rare complication of an identical-twin pregnancy in which one twin has a severely malformed heart or no heart and receives blood from the other twin through shared placental vessels. The healthy twin may develop heart strain and needs specialist monitoring.

Trastuzumab

Trastuzumab is a monoclonal antibody targeting HER2 used for HER2-positive breast, gastric, and other cancers; infusion reactions and potentially reversible cardiomyopathy require cardiac monitoring.

Trauma

Physical injury caused by an outside force, or the mental response to a deeply distressing event. Physical trauma may damage organs, bones, or blood vessels; psychological trauma can affect emotions, sleep, and daily life.

Trauma- And Stressor-Related Disorders

A group of mental disorders involving exposure to a traumatic or stressful event or condition and subsequent emotional, behavioral, or physiologic symptoms. Examples include acute stress disorder, posttraumatic stress disorder, adjustment disorder, reactive attachment disorder, and disinhibited social engagement disorder.

Trauma Center

A hospital organized to provide rapid, coordinated care for seriously injured people. Trauma centers differ in available specialists, equipment, surgery, intensive care, and ability to treat complex injuries.

Trauma Surgery

The surgical specialty concerned with evaluation and operative or nonoperative treatment of acute in-

juries, especially severe or multiple injuries. It often involves coordinated care with emergency medicine, anesthesiology, radiology, and other surgical specialties.

Traumatic Amputation

Loss of a body part caused by an injury. It can cause life-threatening bleeding, shock, infection, and lasting disability; emergency care controls bleeding, treats damaged tissue, preserves the separated part when possible, and begins rehabilitation and psychological support.

Traumatic Bladder and Urethral Injury

Damage to the bladder or urethra caused by an accident, surgery, or penetrating injury. Blood in the urine, inability to urinate, pelvic pain, or shock may occur.

Traumatic Bleb

A fragile, fluid-filled area that forms after glaucoma drainage surgery and is damaged by an injury. It may leak or become infected and can cause dangerously low eye pressure or vision problems.

Traumatic Brain Injury

Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI) is a change in brain function or damage to the brain caused by an external force. It may result from a bump, blow, or jolt to the head or body, a fall, blast, or an object penetrating the skull. Effects range from brief confusion or headache to memory problems, seizures, loss of consciousness, permanent disability, or death. Later swelling, bleeding, low oxygen, or other complications can cause additional brain damage.

Alternate Names:
TBI

Traumatic Brain Injury (Concussion)

Concussion is a mild form of traumatic brain injury; see *Concussion*.

Traumatic Cataract

Clouding of the eye's natural lens caused by an injury, such as a blunt blow, penetrating wound, or chemical or electrical injury. It may appear soon after the injury or develop weeks, months, or years later, sometimes alongside other damage to the eye.

Traumatic Events And Children

Traumatic events can affect children's safety, behavior, sleep, learning, and emotions; supportive caregivers, stable routines, and professional assessment help identify persistent trauma responses.

Traumatic Grief

Alternate name; see *Complicated Grief*.

Traumatic Hemorrhagic Shock

Shock caused by severe blood loss after an injury. Reduced circulating blood volume limits oxygen delivery to organs and may cause fast heartbeat, pale or clammy skin, confusion, low blood pressure, and organ failure.

Traumatic Injury

Damage to the body caused by an external force, such as a fall, collision, blow, cut, burn, or penetrating object. Injury may affect skin, bones, organs, blood vessels, nerves, or the brain.

Traumatic Shock

A life-threatening failure of blood flow after serious injury, often because of major bleeding, but sometimes because of heart damage or another cause. It can cause pale clammy skin, confusion, rapid breathing, and collapse and requires immediate treatment.

Traumatology

The medical field concerned with physical injuries and their consequences. It includes emergency assessment, control of bleeding, repair of damaged tissues, prevention of complications, surgery, and rehabilitation.

Traveler's Diarrhea

Diarrhea during or shortly after travel, usually caused by contaminated food or water and commonly by bacteria, viruses, or parasites. Blood, high fever, severe dehydration, or persistent symptoms can indicate invasive infection or significant

fluid loss.

Travelers' Diarrhea

Alternate spelling; see *Traveler's Diarrhea*.

Travel Sickness

Nausea, dizziness, sweating, or vomiting caused by conflicting signals from the eyes and balance organs during travel or other motion. Symptoms may improve with visual fixation, fresh air, gradual exposure, or preventive medicines; persistent symptoms can have other causes.

Travel Vaccinations

Travel vaccinations are vaccines recommended or required for protection against infections encountered in particular countries or regions. Recommendations depend on the destination, activities, health conditions, and previous vaccinations.

Travoprost

Travoprost is a prostaglandin analogue eye drop that increases uveoscleral outflow and lowers intraocular pressure in glaucoma or ocular hypertension; iris pigmentation and eyelash changes may occur.

Trazodone

A prescription medicine used mainly for depression and sometimes for sleep problems. It can cause drowsiness, dizziness, low blood pressure, falls, and rare prolonged painful erection; dangerous reactions are more likely with certain medicines or substances.

Trazodone Overdose

Poisoning from taking too much trazodone. It can cause severe sleepiness, vomiting, low blood pressure, seizures, abnormal heart rhythms, or a prolonged painful erection.

Trb Gene

A gene involved in biological processes that vary by species; its precise identity and function must be interpreted from the organism and gene nomenclature used.

Trd Gene

The gene encoding the delta chain of the T-cell receptor in humans, contributing to gamma-delta T-cell antigen recognition.

Treacher Collins-Franceschetti Syndrome 1

A craniofacial developmental disorder, usually caused by a variant affecting TCOF1, that may cause underdeveloped cheekbones and jaw, malformed ears, hearing loss, cleft palate, and airway or feeding problems.

Treacher Collins Syndrome

An inherited condition affecting development of the face and skull. It may cause small cheekbones and jaw, downward-slanting eyes, malformed ears, and hearing loss; breathing or feeding may also be difficult. Intelligence is usually normal. Care may include airway support, hearing treatment, and reconstructive surgery.

Treacle

A thick sugar syrup with little current medical use. Older medical writing sometimes used the word for a sweetened mixture or supposed antidote; it is not a modern treatment or diagnosis.

Treatment-Resistant Depression

Depression that does not improve adequately after appropriate trials of standard treatments. It requires reassessment of diagnosis, adherence, comorbidity, and treatment options.

Treatment-Resistant Schizophrenia

Schizophrenia that continues to cause important symptoms or disability despite adequate trials of at least two appropriate antipsychotic medicines. Apparent resistance can also reflect an incorrect diagnosis, inconsistent medicine use, substance effects, or medical illness.

Treat-To-Target Strategy

A treatment approach in which care is checked and adjusted regularly toward a clear goal, such as no disease activity, controlled blood pressure, or a safe

blood-glucose range. The goal and changes are agreed with the patient and based on ongoing monitoring.

Trematoda

A class of parasitic flatworms called flukes; human infections include schistosomiasis and liver or lung fluke disease.

Tremelimumab

A monoclonal antibody that blocks CTLA-4 and enhances T-cell activity; it is used with durvalumab for selected unresectable hepatocellular carcinoma and other cancers, with immune-related adverse effects possible.

Tremor

An involuntary, rhythmic shaking of a body part. It may occur at rest, while holding a position, or during movement and can result from medicines, caffeine, anxiety, essential tremor, Parkinson disease, or other neurologic or metabolic conditions.

Trench Fever

A louse-borne infection caused by Bartonella quintana, causing recurring fever, headache, weakness, and bone pain.

Trench Foot

An injury caused by keeping feet cold and wet for a long time. It can cause numbness, swelling, pain, skin color changes, blisters, infection, and tissue death without gradual warming and medical care.

Trench Mouth

Trench mouth is acute necrotizing ulcerative gingivitis causing painful bleeding gums, foul breath, and ulceration, often associated with plaque, smoking, stress, or poor nutrition.

Trendelenberg Position

Alternate spelling; see *Trendelenburg Position*.

Trendelenburg

Trendelenburg position places the body supine with the feet higher than the head; its use is procedure-specific and may affect breathing, pressure, and circulation.

Trendelenburg Gait

An abnormal gait pattern characterized by a downward pelvic drop toward the unsupported side during the swing phase, or a lateral trunk lurch over the weight-bearing side to compensate for hip abductor weakness. It occurs due to weakness or paralysis of the gluteus medius and minimus muscles or superior gluteal nerve lesion.

Trendelenburg Position

A position lying on the back with the head and upper body lower than the feet. It is used for selected procedures but can worsen breathing, pressure in the head, or blood pressure in some patients.

Trendelenburg Sign

A physical clinical sign indicating weakness or paralysis of the hip abductor muscles (gluteus medius and minimus) innervated by the superior gluteal nerve; when the patient stands on one leg (the affected stance side), the unsupported pelvis tilts downward toward the opposite non-weight-bearing swing side.

Alternate Names:
Trendelenburg Hip Abductor Sign; Positive Trendelenburg Test

Trendelenburg Test

A clinical test used to evaluate the integrity and strength of the hip abductor mechanism (gluteus medius and minimus). The patient stands on one leg; a drop of the pelvis on the contralateral unsupported side indicates abductor weakness or hip instability on the stance side.

Treosulfan

An alkylating chemotherapy drug used in conditioning before allogeneic hematopoietic stem-cell transplantation; infection, mucositis, infertility, and organ toxicities may occur.

Trephine

A circular cutting instrument used to remove a disk

of tissue or bone, such as during a bone-marrow biopsy or corneal procedure.

Treponema

A group of spiral-shaped bacteria, including Treponema pallidum, which causes syphilis. Different species can live in people or the environment, and identifying the species helps determine whether disease and treatment are present.

Treponemal Infections

Infections caused by spiral-shaped Treponema bacteria. They include syphilis and related diseases and may affect the skin, nerves, heart, eyes, or other organs; diagnosis usually combines clinical findings with blood or lesion tests.

Treponema Pallidum

The spiral-shaped bacterium that causes syphilis. It spreads mainly through contact with an infectious sore during sex and can cross the placenta to an unborn baby. Untreated infection can later affect the skin, nerves, eyes, heart, or brain.

Treponema Pallidum Infection

Infection with the bacterium Treponema pallidum, which causes syphilis and can affect the skin, nervous system, cardiovascular system, and other organs.

Trepopnea

Breathlessness that occurs or becomes worse when lying on one side but not the other. It can result from disease affecting one lung, fluid around a lung, or pressure from a nearby mass.

Tretinoin

A vitamin-A-related medicine applied to the skin for acne and sun-related skin changes, or taken by mouth for a type of acute leukemia. Skin irritation is common; oral treatment can cause serious fluid buildup, fever, and breathing problems.

TRG Gene

A gene encoding the gamma chain of the T-cell receptor, contributing to gamma-delta T-cell development and antigen recognition.

Triage

Assessment and sorting of patients by how urgently they need medical care. In emergency care, it identifies those who need immediate treatment and those who can safely wait. During a mass-casualty event, triage also helps allocate limited staff and supplies.

Trial Of Labor After Cesarean

An attempt to give birth vaginally after a previous cesarean delivery. Whether it is appropriate depends on the prior uterine incision, obstetric history, current pregnancy, facility resources, and the person's preferences. Counseling includes the possibility of successful VBAC, repeat cesarean delivery, and uterine rupture.

Triamcinolone

A corticosteroid medicine used on skin, by injection, or in other forms to reduce inflammation and itching.

Triamcinolone Acetonide

A synthetic corticosteroid used topically, by injection, or in other preparations to reduce inflammation; prolonged or extensive use can cause local and systemic steroid effects.

Triamterene

A water tablet that helps the kidneys remove salt and water while conserving potassium. It is used for high blood pressure or swelling, but can cause dangerously high potassium, kidney problems, or kidney stones.

Triangle of Doom

A laparoscopic anatomical region in the pelvis bounded by the vas deferens medially, the spermatic (testicular) vessels laterally, and the peritoneal reflection inferiorly. It contains the external iliac artery and vein and deep circumflex iliac vein, which are vulnerable to injury during inguinal hernia repair.

Alternate Names:
Laparoscopic Vascular Danger Triangle; Inguinal Triangle of Doom

Triangle of Pain

A laparoscopic anatomical region in the groin bounded by the spermatic vessels medially, the iliopubic tract superolaterally, and the peritoneal reflection inferiorly. It contains the femoral branch of the genitofemoral nerve, lateral femoral cutaneous nerve, and femoral nerve; injury can cause chronic groin pain or numbness.

Alternate Names:
Laparoscopic Neural Danger Triangle; Inguinal Triangle of Pain

Triazenes

A group of chemical compounds that includes some chemotherapy medicines. Their effects and risks depend on the specific drug; possible problems include nausea, low blood counts, infection, and damage to other organs.

Triaziquone

An older alkylating anticancer drug that cross-links DNA; its clinical use is limited by toxicity and availability.

Triazolam

Triazolam is a short-acting benzodiazepine hypnotic for short-term insomnia; amnesia, falls, dependence, respiratory depression, and dangerous interactions with opioids or other sedatives can occur.

Triazole

A five-membered nitrogen-containing chemical ring found in several antifungal medicines and other drugs; clinical effects depend on the specific compound.

Triazophos

An organophosphate insecticide that blocks acetylcholinesterase, allowing nerve signals to remain active. Significant exposure can cause sweating, vomiting, diarrhea, small pupils, breathing difficulty, weakness, seizures, or life-threatening poisoning.

Triceps

A muscle with three heads, especially the triceps brachii at the back of the upper arm. It straightens the elbow and helps stabilize the shoulder; injury or nerve problems can weaken pushing and lifting.

Triceps Brachii Muscle

The large muscle at the back of the upper arm. It straightens the elbow and helps move and stabilize the shoulder; injury or nerve damage can weaken pushing and lifting.

Triceps Reflex

A monosynaptic deep tendon stretch reflex elicited by tapping the triceps brachii tendon immediately superior to the olecranon process with a reflex hammer, stretching muscle spindles and provoking reflex forearm extension mediated through the radial nerve (evaluating spinal cord segments C7 and C8).

Alternate Names:
Triceps Tendon Reflex; C7 Reflex

Trichiasis

Inward misdirection of eyelashes so they rub against the eye.

Trichilemmal Carcinoma

A rare malignant follicular tumor showing outer-root-sheath differentiation, usually occurring on sun-damaged skin of older adults as a papule or nodule; complete excision is generally required.

Trichilemmal Cyst (Pilar Cyst)

A usually benign keratin-filled cyst arising from the outer root sheath of a hair follicle, most often on the scalp. It is typically a firm, mobile lump and may become inflamed, rupture, or rarely develop a proliferating pilar tumor.

Trichilemmoma

A usually harmless tumor arising from a hair follicle, most often appearing as a small skin-colored bump on the face. Multiple growths can be associated with an inherited condition called Cowden syndrome.

Trichinellosis

Trichinellosis is an infection caused by Trichinella

worms, usually after eating undercooked infected meat. It may cause diarrhea followed by fever, muscle pain, and swelling around the eyes.

Trichiniasis

An infection caused by Trichinella larvae, acquired from undercooked meat.

Trichinosis

Infection with *Trichinella* worms, usually acquired by eating undercooked infected pork or wild game. It may cause diarrhea, fever, muscle pain, and swelling around the eyes.

Trichobezoar

A mass of swallowed hair in the digestive tract, usually the stomach, which may cause pain, vomiting, or blockage.

Trichoblastoma

A rare benign follicular tumor of the scalp or face, usually presenting as a solitary dermal or subcutaneous nodule; it can resemble basal-cell carcinoma and is diagnosed histologically.

Trichoepithelioma

A rare benign follicular adnexal tumor that usually presents as a skin-coloured papule or nodule on the face or scalp; it can resemble basal-cell carcinoma and may require histopathologic confirmation.

Trichomonas

A flagellated protozoan, Trichomonas vaginalis, that infects the urogenital tract and causes trichomoniasis. It is transmitted mainly through sexual contact and may cause discharge, irritation, or no symptoms.

Trichomonas Vaginalis

A flagellated protozoan that causes trichomoniasis, a sexually transmitted infection.

Trichomoniasis

A sexually transmitted infection caused by the parasite *Trichomonas vaginalis*. It may cause vaginal discharge, itching, or irritation, but many people have no symptoms. It can affect the vagina, urethra, or other genital tissues.

Trichophyton

A group of fungi that grow in keratin and cause ringworm infections of skin, hair, or nails. They spread through contact with infected people, animals, or objects and are treated with antifungal medicines.

Trichorrhexis Nodosa

A hair-shaft defect in which weakened points split into brush-like ends, caused by inherited disease, trauma, chemicals, heat, or nutritional or metabolic disorders.

Trichoscopy

Dermoscopic examination of the scalp and hair using magnification and special lighting. It reveals hair-shaft, follicular, and scalp patterns that help assess hair loss and distinguish scarring from nonscarring disorders.

Trichostasis Spinulosa

A follicular disorder in which many fine vellus hairs become retained in a dilated follicle, producing dark, rough, spiny papules often on the back, chest, or face. It is benign and may improve with topical keratolytics, retinoids, or hair-removal methods.

Trichothiodystrophy Syndrome

A group of inherited disorders characterized by brittle sulfur-deficient hair with a distinctive banded appearance, often accompanied by photosensitivity, ichthyosis, developmental delay, short stature, or recurrent infection.

Trichotillomania

An obsessive-compulsive and related disorder involving recurrent pulling out of one's hair, resulting in hair loss, with repeated attempts to decrease or stop. The behavior causes clinically significant distress or impairment and is not better explained by a skin or other medical condition or another mental disorder. Hair may be pulled from the scalp, eyebrows, eyelashes, or other body sites.

Trichotillomania (Hair-Pulling Disorder)

Alternate name; see *Trichotillomania*.

Trichuriasis

Intestinal infection caused by the whipworm *Trichuris trichiura*, usually acquired by swallowing eggs from contaminated soil or food. Heavy infection can cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, anemia, or rectal prolapse.

Tricuspid Annular Plane Systolic Excursion

A measurement made during an echocardiogram that shows how far part of the tricuspid valve moves as the right ventricle contracts. A low value may indicate reduced right-heart pumping and is interpreted with the complete scan and clinical findings.

Alternate Names:
TAPSE; Tricuspid Annular Excursion; RV Longitudinal Systolic Function

Tricuspid Atresia

A congenital absence or complete closure of the tricuspid valve, blocking normal flow from the right atrium to the right ventricle. Survival depends on an atrial communication and usually a ventricular septal defect or patent ductus to allow blood to reach the lungs; newborns typically have cyanosis and undergo staged surgical treatment.

Tricuspid Incompetence

Incomplete closure of the tricuspid heart valve, allowing blood to leak backward into the right upper chamber. Severe leakage can cause swelling, liver congestion, irregular heartbeat, fatigue, and breathlessness.

Tricuspid Regurgitation

Backward flow through the tricuspid valve from the right ventricle to the right atrium during systole. It may result from primary valve disease or annular enlargement caused by right-ventricular or right-atrial dilation, pulmonary hypertension, or left-sided heart disease; severe regurgitation can cause fatigue, edema, ascites, liver congestion, or right-sided heart failure.

Tricuspid Stenosis

Narrowing of the tricuspid valve opening that restricts blood flow from the right upper chamber (right atrium) to the right lower chamber (right ventricle). It is most often caused by rheumatic fever and often occurs alongside mitral valve disease. The restriction increases pressure in the veins returning blood to the heart, leading to swollen neck veins, leg swelling, an enlarged liver, and fatigue.

Alternate Names:
Tricuspid Valve Stenosis; TS

Tricuspid Valve

The heart valve between the right upper and right lower chambers. It opens to let blood move forward and closes to prevent backflow; leakage or narrowing can strain the heart.

Tricuspid Valve Disease

Alternate name; see *Tricuspid Regurgitation* and *Tricuspid stenosis*.

Tricyclic Antidepressant Drugs

A group of older antidepressants that increase certain chemical signals in the brain. They can also cause dry mouth, constipation, sleepiness, dangerous heart rhythms, and serious poisoning in overdose.

Tricyclic Antidepressants

Antidepressants that block reuptake of serotonin and norepinephrine, with additional anticholinergic, antihistaminic, and alpha-adrenergic blocking effects. Examples include amitriptyline, nortriptyline, imipramine, and desipramine. They are effective for depression, neuropathic pain, and migraine prophylaxis.

Alternate Names:
Tricyclics; First-Generation Antidepressants

Tricyclic Antidepressant Toxicity

Rapid anticholinergic and sodium-channel toxicity causing dry skin, mydriasis, delirium, seizures, hypotension, QRS widening, ventricular dysrhythmias, and coma. Obtain an ECG early; airway support, intravenous sodium bicarbonate for QRS widen-

ing or ventricular toxicity, and benzodiazepines for seizures are key interventions.

Trifluoperazine

A phenothiazine antipsychotic used for selected psychotic disorders. It can cause drowsiness, movement disorders, and other serious adverse effects.

Trigeminal Nerve

The fifth cranial nerve, carrying sensation from the face and controlling muscles used for chewing.

Trigeminal Neuralgia

A chronic pain disorder causing sudden, repeated bursts of severe electric-shock-like, stabbing, or burning pain on one side of the face along one or more branches of the trigeminal nerve, the fifth cranial nerve. Attacks usually last from a fraction of a second to about two minutes and may occur in clusters, with pain-free periods between them. Light touch, brushing the teeth, eating, drinking, speaking, or a breeze may trigger an attack. The usual cause is pressure on the nerve near the brainstem, but multiple sclerosis, a tumor, or another nerve disorder can sometimes be responsible.

Alternate Names:
Tic Douloureux; Fothergill Disease

Trigeminal Trophic Syndrome

A rare facial ulcer syndrome caused by injury to the trigeminal nerve or its central sensory pathways. Reduced or absent sensation together with abnormal sensations, such as itching or tingling, can lead to repeated rubbing or scratching and a persistent or recurrent ulcer, most often on the side of the nose. Causes include nerve procedures, stroke, and shingles affecting the trigeminal nerve.

Trigger

A trigger is an event, exposure, stimulus, or condition that initiates or worsens a symptom, disease episode, behavior, or physiologic response.

Trigger Finger

A condition in which a finger tendon catches as it moves through a tight covering. It can cause pain, clicking, stiffness, or locking and may improve with rest, injections, splinting, or surgery.

Alternate Names:
Stenosing Tenosynovitis; Snapping Digit

Trigger Finger Release

A procedure that opens the tight tunnel around a finger tendon so the finger can move more freely. It may be offered when rest, a splint, or an injection has not helped. Movement often improves, but recovery and results vary and infection, nerve injury, pain, or continued symptoms can occur.

Alternate Names:
A1 Pulley Release; Trigger Thumb Release; Stenosing Tenosynovitis Surgery; Percutaneous Trigger Finger Release

Trigger Thumb

A condition in which the thumb tendon catches as it moves through a tight covering. It may cause pain, clicking, stiffness, or locking and can often be treated with rest, splinting, an injection, or surgery.

Triglyceride

An ester derived from glycerol and three fatty acid molecules, representing the principal dietary lipid and primary storage form of metabolic energy in human adipose tissue. Circulating in plasma packaged within triglyceride-rich lipoproteins (chylomicrons from intestinal absorption and very low-density lipoproteins [VLDL] from hepatic synthesis), triglycerides are hydrolyzed by endothelial lipoprotein lipase (LPL) to release free fatty acids for peripheral muscle oxidation or adipocyte re-esterification. Fasting hypertriglyceridemia ($>$ 150 mg/dL) is an independent marker of atherogenic cardiovascular risk, and severe hypertriglyceridemia ($> 500 - -1,000$ mg/dL) markedly increases the risk of acute pancreatitis.

Alternate Names:
Triglycerides; Triacylglycerol; TG

Triglyceride Level

A triglyceride level measures a type of fat in the blood; persistently high levels can increase cardiovascular risk and, when very high, cause pancreatitis.

Triglycerides

Plural form; see *Triglyceride*.

Triglyceride Test

A blood test measuring circulating triglycerides, the primary form of stored body fat, used to evaluate cardiovascular risk and metabolic health; see *Triglyceride* and *Lipid Profile*.

Trigone

A triangular area, especially the smooth region at the base of the urinary bladder between the ureter openings and urine outlet. It helps direct urine flow and can be affected by inflammation or tumors.

Triiodothyronine

The thyroid hormone T3, which contains three iodine atoms and has stronger biological activity than T4. It helps regulate metabolism, heart rate, temperature, and growth.

Trimester

One of the three roughly equal periods of pregnancy. Each lasts about three months, or 13 to 14 weeks.

Trimethoprim

An antibiotic that blocks bacterial folate production and is often combined with sulfamethoxazole. It treats selected infections but can cause rash, blood-cell changes, high potassium, kidney effects, or medicine interactions.

Trimethoprim-Sulfamethoxazole

An antibiotic combination that blocks bacteria from making folate, which they need to grow. It treats selected urinary, lung, skin, and other infections but can cause allergy, blood-count changes, high potassium, or kidney problems.

Trimethylaminuria

A metabolic disorder in which impaired oxidation of trimethylamine causes a characteristic fish-like body odor in sweat, urine, and breath. It may be inherited or acquired and can cause substantial psychosocial distress despite limited physical illness.

Trimipramine

A sedating tricyclic antidepressant used for depression in some countries. Its anticholinergic and cardiovascular effects can cause dry mouth, constipation, blurred vision, drowsiness, orthostatic hypotension, or dangerous toxicity in overdose; interactions and suicide risk require clinical monitoring.

Trinitrin

Another name for glyceryl trinitrate or nitroglycerin, a nitrate vasodilator.

Trinitrophenol

Picric acid, a corrosive and potentially explosive chemical once used in medicine, laboratories, and industry.

Trinucleotide Repeat

A short DNA sequence of three building blocks repeated many times. Extra copies can interfere with genes and cause inherited disorders such as Huntington disease, fragile X syndrome, myotonic dystrophy, or Friedreich ataxia.

Trip

A trip is a journey or an accidental stumble; in drug-related language it can also mean an episode of altered perception after a hallucinogen.

Tripe Palms

Diffuse, velvety, thickened hyperkeratosis of the palmar skin with a cerebriform, corrugated appearance resembling the lining of a cow's stomach (tripe), which is strongly associated with underlying malignancy, most commonly gastric adenocarcinoma. It may occur alone or in conjunction with acanthosis nigricans.

Triple-Negative Breast Cancer

A subtype of invasive breast cancer whose tumor cells test negative for estrogen receptor (ER) and progesterone receptor (PR) and lack HER2 overexpression. These three biomarker results distinguish it from hormone receptor-positive and HER2-positive breast cancers.

Triplets

Three offspring born from the same pregnancy or three infants born in a multiple birth.

Triple X Syndrome

A sex-chromosome variation in which a female has an extra X chromosome. Many affected people have typical sexual development and fertility, while some have tall stature, speech or learning difficulties, coordination problems, or anxiety; severity varies widely.

Alternate Names:
Trisomy X; 47,XXX Syndrome

Triploidy Syndrome

A chromosome condition in which cells have three complete sets of chromosomes instead of two. It usually causes severe growth restriction and multiple birth defects and often prevents long-term survival; rare mosaic forms may be less severe.

Triptan

A class of prescription medications specifically designed to relieve acute migraine headaches and cluster headaches. They work by mimicking serotonin, a chemical messenger in the brain, which causes swollen blood vessels around the brain to constrict and blocks pain-signaling pathways in the nervous system. While effective at relieving throbbing pain, nausea, and light sensitivity during an active migraine attack, they are not intended to prevent future headaches.

Alternate Names:
Triptans; 5-HT1B/1D Agonist

Triptans

Plural form; see *Triptan*.

Triquetrum

One of the small bones on the little-finger side of the wrist. It helps stabilize the wrist and can be injured by a fall or direct blow, causing pain and swelling.

Trismus

Difficulty opening the mouth because the jaw muscles are tight or painful. Causes include dental infection, injury, medicines, muscle disorders, and tetanus; severe or rapidly worsening restriction can interfere with eating or breathing.

Trisodium Phosphate Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing or contacting trisodium phosphate, a strong alkaline cleaner. It can burn the mouth, throat, eyes, and skin and may cause vomiting or breathing problems.

Trisomy

A chromosome condition in which cells have an extra copy of a whole chromosome or chromosome segment, giving three copies instead of the usual two. It may affect all cells or only some cells (mosaicism); effects depend on the chromosome or segment involved and may include developmental differences, birth defects, or pregnancy loss.

Trisomy 13

Patau syndrome, a chromosomal disorder caused by an extra chromosome 13 and associated with severe developmental, brain, facial, heart, kidney, and limb abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
D Trisomy Syndrome; Patau Syndrome

Trisomy 13 Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Patau Syndrome*.

Trisomy 18

Edwards syndrome, a chromosomal disorder caused by an extra chromosome 18 and associated with growth restriction, characteristic craniofacial and limb findings, heart disease, and severe developmental impairment.

Trisomy 18 Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Edwards Syndrome*.

Trisomy 21

Down syndrome, a genetic condition caused by an

extra copy of chromosome 21. It may affect learning, growth, muscle tone, the heart, hearing, vision, or other organs; the features and level of support needed vary widely.

Trisomy 21 Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Down Syndrome*.

Trisomy X

Alternate name; see *Triple X Syndrome*.

Trocar

A pointed instrument placed inside a hollow tube to enter a body cavity or tissue. It is used in minimally invasive procedures to create an opening for cameras, instruments, or drainage tubes.

Trochanter

A bony projection on the thigh bone, especially the larger outer or smaller inner projection. Muscles and tendons attach there, and irritation around the greater trochanter can cause outer-hip pain.

Trochanteric Bursitis

Alternate name; see *Greater Trochanteric Pain Syndrome*.

Troche

A troche is a small medicated lozenge that dissolves slowly in the mouth or throat for local or systemic drug delivery.

Trochlear Nerve

Cranial nerve IV, which supplies the superior oblique eye muscle. Injury can cause vertical or tilted double vision, often worse when looking down or inward.

Trochlear Nerve Palsy

A cranial neuropathy involving the fourth cranial nerve (CN IV), causing paralysis of the superior oblique muscle, presenting with vertical and torsional diplopia (characteristically worse on downgaze and reading), an upward and inward hypertropia of the affected eye, and a compensatory head tilt toward the opposite contralateral shoulder (Bielschowsky head tilt test).

Alternate Names:
Fourth Nerve Palsy; CN IV Palsy

Trophic

Relating to the nutrition, growth, development, or maintenance of tissue. Trophic changes may occur when nerve supply or blood flow is impaired.

Trophoblast

The outer cell layer of an early embryo that attaches to the uterus and helps form the placenta. It supports implantation, exchanges nutrients, and produces hormones needed to maintain early pregnancy.

Trophoderm

The outer layer of cells in a very early embryo before it attaches to the uterus. It helps the embryo implant and develops into tissues that form much of the placenta.

Trophozoite

The active stage of a single-celled parasite. In this stage it feeds, grows, and often multiplies; it differs from the more resistant form that some parasites use to survive outside the body.

Tropical Disease

Any disease or infectious illness that occurs solely, or is predominantly prevalent, in tropical and subtropical regions where warm, humid climates support abundant insect and arachnid vectors and intermediate hosts. Encompassing malaria, leishmaniasis, schistosomiasis, lymphatic filariasis, Chagas disease, dengue fever, and yellow fever, many are designated neglected tropical diseases (NTDs) closely linked to sanitation, poverty, and vector ecology.

Alternate Names:
Tropical Diseases; Neglected Tropical Diseases

Tropical Diseases

Plural form; see *Tropical Disease*.

Tropical Medicine

The medical specialty concerned with diseases common in tropical and subtropical regions and illnesses related to travel. It includes infections, parasites, insect-borne diseases, environmental hazards, prevention, diagnosis, and treatment.

Tropical Sprue

A disorder causing long-lasting diarrhea and poor absorption of nutrients, reported mainly in tropical and subtropical areas. It can lead to weight loss and deficiencies of folate, iron, and vitamin B12. Testing helps exclude infection and other causes; treatment usually includes antibiotics and replacement of missing nutrients.

Tropical Ulcer

A chronic ulcer occurring in tropical regions, often associated with infection, trauma, or poor wound healing.

Troponin

A protein released into the blood when heart muscle is injured. A raised level can support a heart-attack diagnosis, but it may also result from other heart, lung, kidney, or severe systemic illnesses.

Troponin I

An inhibitory subunit of the troponin regulatory complex of cardiac striated muscle; cardiac troponin I (cTnI) possesses an amino acid sequence unique to myocardium, serving as an exquisitely sensitive and specific clinical blood biomarker for acute myocardial injury and infarction.

Alternate Names:
cTnI; Cardiac Troponin I

Troponin Test

A troponin test measures heart-muscle proteins in the blood and helps assess possible heart injury, especially during suspected heart attack.

Trouble Swallowing

Difficulty moving food or liquid from the mouth to the stomach. It may cause coughing, choking, pain, or a feeling that food is stuck in the throat or chest.

Trousseau Sign

A carpopedal spasm that may occur when blood flow to the arm is briefly reduced with a blood-pressure cuff. It can suggest increased neuromuscular excitability, often from low blood calcium, but is not specific.

Trousseau Sign Of Latent Tetany

Alternate name; see *Trousseau Sign*.

Alternate Names:
Trousseau Sign; Carpopedal Spasm Sign

Trousseau Sign of Malignancy

Spontaneous, migratory superficial thrombophlebitis characterized by recurrent tender, erythematous venous cords appearing sequentially in different superficial veins of the extremities and trunk, strongly associated with underlying visceral mucinous adenocarcinomas, particularly of the pancreas.

Alternate Names:
Trousseau Syndrome; Migratory Thrombophlebitis

Trousseau Syndrome

Repeated or shifting blood clots in veins associated with active cancer, especially some cancers of the pancreas, stomach, or lung. The cancer can make the blood clot too easily; it differs from the hand spasm called Trousseau sign.

Trp

Trp is the standard abbreviation for tryptophan, an essential amino acid used in protein synthesis and serotonin and niacin pathways.

True Ribs

The first seven pairs of ribs, each attached directly to the breastbone by its own flexible cartilage. They protect the heart and lungs and move with the chest during breathing.

Truncation

A shortened or incomplete form caused by removal of

part of a sequence, structure, chromosome, protein, or process; the effect depends on what was lost and where.

Truncus Arteriosus

A birth defect in which one large blood vessel leaves the heart instead of separate vessels for the body and lungs. A large hole between the lower chambers usually allows oxygen-poor and oxygen-rich blood to mix, causing blue skin and heart failure. Early surgery is usually required.

Trunk

The central part of the body excluding the head and limbs, or a major nerve or vessel trunk.

Trypanosoma

A genus of protozoan parasites causing African and American trypanosomiasis.

Trypanosoma Brucei

A protozoan parasite transmitted by tsetse flies that causes African trypanosomiasis, or sleeping sickness. The human-infecting subspecies differ in geographic distribution and typical disease course; infection can progress from fever and lymph-node enlargement to neurologic involvement.

Trypanosomiasis

Disease caused by Trypanosoma parasites, including African sleeping sickness and Chagas disease. Infected insects spread them, and illness may affect blood, lymph nodes, the nervous system, heart, or digestive organs.

Trypsin

A digestive enzyme made by the pancreas and activated in the small intestine. It breaks proteins in food into smaller parts and activates other pancreatic digestive enzymes.

Trypsin And Chymotrypsin In Stool

Stool trypsin and chymotrypsin testing measures digestive enzymes and may help assess pancreatic enzyme production, although other tests are often preferred.

Trypsinogen Test

A trypsinogen test measures a pancreatic enzyme precursor and may help evaluate pancreatic function or newborn screening for cystic fibrosis.

Tryptophan

An amino acid the body cannot make and must obtain from food. It is used to make proteins and can be changed into serotonin, melatonin, and niacin, which help regulate mood, sleep, and other body functions.

Tsetse Fly

A blood-feeding fly found in parts of sub-Saharan Africa. Its bite can spread Trypanosoma parasites, which cause African sleeping sickness; infection may cause fever, headaches, behavior changes, sleep disturbance, and serious nervous-system disease.

TSH

Thyroid-stimulating hormone, made by the pituitary gland to tell the thyroid to produce its hormones. A blood TSH measurement is commonly the first test for many thyroid problems.

TSH-Receptor Antibody

An antibody that attaches to the thyroid's control receptor. Some antibodies overstimulate the thyroid and cause Graves disease, while others block its activity; testing can help diagnose thyroid disease and assess pregnancy-related risk.

TSH Test

A TSH test measures thyroid-stimulating hormone in the blood and is a common initial test of thyroid function.

TSI Test

A blood test that detects antibodies which overstimulate the thyroid. It can support the diagnosis or monitoring of Graves disease and may help assess risk to a fetus during pregnancy.

Tsutsugamushi Fever

Scrub typhus, a mite-borne infection caused by Orientia tsutsugamushi. It may cause fever, headache, rash, an eschar, and organ complications and is treated with an appropriate antibiotic.

Tubal Ectopic Pregnancy

A pregnancy implanted in a fallopian tube rather than inside the uterus. It may cause pelvic pain or vaginal bleeding, though early symptoms may be absent. It cannot develop normally to birth; as it grows, it can rupture the tube and cause severe internal bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Tubal Pregnancy

Tubal Factor Infertility

Infertility caused by blocked, scarred, or otherwise damaged fallopian tubes. The damage can stop sperm and egg from meeting or keep a fertilized egg from moving toward the uterus, and can raise the risk of ectopic pregnancy. Causes include pelvic infection, endometriosis, surgery, or a condition present from birth.

Tubal Ligation

A permanent birth-control procedure that closes, cuts, or removes the fallopian tubes so sperm and egg cannot normally meet. It does not protect against sexually transmitted infections, and pregnancy after the procedure, though uncommon, can be ectopic.

Tubal Ligation Reversal

Microsurgical reconnection of previously divided or blocked fallopian-tube segments to restore a possible path for sperm and egg; success depends on remaining tube length, age, scarring, and original method.

Tubercle

A small rounded projection or nodule; it may refer to bone anatomy or a tuberculous lesion.

Tuberculide

A skin eruption caused by an immune reaction to tuberculosis elsewhere in the body. The skin lesions usually contain no bacteria and may improve when the underlying tuberculosis is treated.

Tuberculin

Protein material from Mycobacterium tuberculosis used in a skin test for immune sensitization. A positive result suggests exposure or vaccination but does not by itself prove active tuberculosis or show when exposure occurred.

Tuberculin Skin Test

A small amount of tuberculosis protein is injected into the skin. The raised, firm area is measured 2 to 3 days later; the result depends on its size and the person's risk factors and does not by itself distinguish latent from active tuberculosis.

Tuberculin Test

A skin test that checks whether the immune system has reacted to tuberculosis proteins. A positive result suggests infection or previous vaccination and does not by itself prove active disease.

Tuberculoid Leprosy

A form of leprosy in which the immune system keeps the number of bacteria low. It usually causes a few pale or reddish skin patches with reduced feeling and can injure nearby nerves, causing weakness or numbness.

Tuberculosis

A contagious bacterial infection caused by *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* that primarily affects the lungs, though it can spread to other parts of the body such as the kidneys, spine, or brain. It spreads through the air when an infected person coughs, sneezes, or speaks. Many infected individuals develop a latent form with no symptoms, but if the immune system weakens, the bacteria can become active, causing a chronic cough (often with blood), fever, drenching night sweats, chest pain, and severe unexplained weight loss.

Alternate Names:

TB; Consumption; Phthisis

Tuberculosis In Children

Tuberculosis infection in a child, usually acquired by breathing air containing the bacteria from an infectious person. It may be silent or cause cough, fever, poor growth, night sweats, or swollen lymph nodes; testing and treatment depend on exposure and findings.

Tuberculosis Interferon-Gamma Release Assay

A blood test (IGRA) that measures cellular immune reactivity to *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* antigens; see *Interferon-Gamma Release Assay*.

Tuberculosis (TB)

See *Tuberculosis*.

Tuberculous Meningitis

A life-threatening infection of the coverings of the brain caused by tuberculosis bacteria. It may cause persistent headache, fever, vomiting, neck stiffness, confusion, seizures, or weakness.

Tuberculous Mastitis

A rare form of tuberculosis infection in breast tissue. It may cause a lump, pain, skin changes, or an abscess and can resemble breast cancer or other breast infections. The diagnosis is confirmed by finding tuberculosis bacteria or their effects in breast fluid or tissue.

Tuberculous Pleural Effusion

See *Pleural Tuberculosis*.

Tuberose Sclerosis

Historical or variant name for tuberous sclerosis complex, a genetic disorder causing benign tumors in multiple organs, including the brain, skin, kidneys, heart, lungs, or eyes.

Tuberous Sclerosis

A rare genetic disorder, also called tuberous sclerosis complex, that causes growths in the brain and other organs, including the skin, kidneys, heart, and lungs. It may cause seizures, developmental or behavioral problems, and skin changes; the severity varies widely.

Tuberous Sclerosis-1

A form of tuberous sclerosis complex associated with pathogenic variants in the *TSC1* gene. Features may include seizures, developmental or behavioral differences, skin findings, and benign tumors in several organs.

Tuberous Sclerosis Complex

An autosomal dominant genetic disorder, usually caused by a pathogenic variant in *TSC1* or *TSC2*, that produces benign tumors and other abnormalities in multiple organs. Common features include cortical brain lesions, seizures, facial angiofibromas or pale skin macules, renal angiomyolipomas, and cardiac rhabdomyomas; expression varies widely.

Tubes

Hollow structures that carry air, fluid, food, or medical instruments. Examples include breathing tubes, fallopian tubes, drainage tubes, and blood vessels; the specific structure depends on context.

Tubography

Contrast imaging of the fallopian tubes, usually as part of hysterosalpingography, to see whether they are open. It may help assess infertility but can cause temporary cramping, bleeding, infection, or rarely injury.

Tubo-Ovarian Abscess

A pocket of pus involving a fallopian tube and ovary, usually caused by a pelvic infection. It can cause pelvic pain, fever, and severe illness and may need antibiotics, drainage, or surgery.

Tubular Adenoma

A benign glandular polyp, most often in the colon, that can develop dysplastic changes and is considered a precursor lesion for some colorectal cancers.

Tubular Maximum

The maximum transport rate across the renal tubular epithelium for a filtered solute (such as glucose, phosphate, or amino acids), representing the point of carrier protein saturation beyond which any additional filtered load spills directly into the urine.

Alternate Names:
Tm; Transport Maximum

Tubular Reabsorption

The process by which kidney tubules return useful water and dissolved substances from filtered fluid to the blood. This prevents the loss of most water, salt, glucose, and other substances in urine.

Tubular Secretion

The movement of selected medicines, waste products, and extra ions from the blood into kidney tubules. This helps the kidneys remove substances from the body and regulate fluid and salt balance.

Tubule

A small tube in the body. In the kidney, tubules change filtered fluid by taking useful water and substances back into the blood and leaving waste to form urine; other tubules carry fluids in different organs.

Tubuloglomerular Feedback

A kidney control system that adjusts blood flow and filtration according to how much salt reaches part of a kidney tubule. It helps keep filtration and fluid balance reasonably stable.

Tubulointerstitial Diseases of the Kidney

Disorders that primarily injure renal tubules and the surrounding interstitial tissue rather than the glomeruli. They may cause impaired urine concentration, electrolyte or acid-base abnormalities, sterile pyuria, mild proteinuria, and acute or chronic loss of kidney function.

Tubulointerstitial Nephritis

A pattern of renal parenchymal inflammation predominantly centered on the renal interstitial compartment and tubules rather than the glomeruli, classically triggered by allergic adverse reactions to medications (beta-lactams, NSAIDs, PPIs), autoimmune diseases, or direct infections.

Alternate Names:
TIN; Interstitial Nephritis

Tubulointerstitial Nephropathy

Kidney damage involving the small tubes that process urine and the tissue around them. Medicines, infections, toxins, autoimmune disease, and inherited conditions can cause it and may reduce kidney function.

Tularaemia

A zoonotic infection caused by Francisella tularensis, acquired from animals, ticks, contaminated water, or aerosols.

Tularemia

Tularemia is infection with Francisella tularensis acquired from ticks, animals, contaminated water, or aerosols and causing ulcer-glandular, pulmonary, or other disease.

Alternate Names:
Deerfly Fever; Rabbit Fever; Francisella Tularensis Infection

Tularemia Blood Test

A tularemia blood test looks for antibodies or other evidence of infection with Francisella tularensis; antibodies may not appear early in illness.

Tulle Gras

A paraffin-impregnated gauze dressing used to cover wounds and burns.

Tullio Phenomenon

Dizziness, eye movements, or balance problems triggered by loud sounds. It can occur with inner-ear conditions such as superior semicircular canal dehiscence or a perilymphatic fistula, but testing is needed to find the cause.

Alternate Names:
Sound-Induced Vertigo; Acoustic Vestibular Phe-

nomenon

Tumescence

Swelling or enlargement caused by increased blood flow, fluid, or tissue growth. The term commonly describes erection but can also refer to temporary or abnormal enlargement in other body tissues.

Tumor

An abnormal mass formed by cells growing more than they should or surviving when they should not. A tumor may be noncancerous and remain localized, or cancerous and invade nearby tissue or spread.

Tumor Board

A meeting in which doctors from different specialties review a person's cancer diagnosis and test results together. They discuss the possible treatment options and coordinate a care plan.

Tumor Burden

The total amount of cancer in the body, estimated from the number, size, and spread of tumor deposits. It can help doctors assess disease extent and treatment response but does not alone determine a person's outlook.

Tumor Differentiation

How closely tumor cells resemble the normal cells from which they arose. Well-differentiated tumors look and behave more like normal tissue, while poorly differentiated tumors often behave more aggressively.

Tumor Embolism

A blockage caused when cancer cells or a piece of a tumor travels through the bloodstream and lodges in another vessel, most often in the lungs. It can impair blood flow and may cause breathing or other organ problems.

Tumor Grade

A description of how abnormal cancer cells look under a microscope compared with normal cells. Lower-grade tumors often grow more slowly, while higher-grade tumors may grow or spread more quickly; grade is different from cancer stage.

Tumor Grading

The process of examining cancer cells under a microscope and assigning a grade according to how different they look from normal cells. Lower-grade tumors often grow more slowly, while higher-grade tumors may behave more aggressively; grade is different from stage.

Tumor Heterogeneity

Differences between cancer cells in the same tumor or between the original tumor and its spread. These differences can affect how quickly cancer grows and why some cells respond to treatment while others resist it.

Tumor-Infiltrating Lymphocyte Therapy

A cellular cancer treatment using immune cells removed from a tumor, selected or expanded in the laboratory, and returned to the person to attack cancer cells. It is used for selected advanced cancers and requires specialized treatment because serious immune and treatment-related complications can occur.

Tumor Lysis Syndrome

A metabolic complication of rapid tumor-cell breakdown, which may occur spontaneously or after cancer treatment. Released cell contents cause characteristic abnormalities, including high blood potassium, phosphate, and uric acid and low calcium. These changes can lead to acute kidney injury, abnormal heart rhythms, seizures, or other organ complications.

Tumor Marker

A substance found in blood, urine, tissue, or another body fluid that may be produced by cancer or by the body's response to it. Tumor markers can help monitor treatment or recurrence and sometimes guide diagnosis, but most are not specific enough to prove cancer alone.

Tumor Mutational Burden

The number of gene changes found in a sample of cancer. A high number may help predict response to some immunotherapy, but the result depends on the test, cancer type, and other tumor features.

Tumor Necrosis Factor

An immune-system messenger that promotes inflammation, fever, and activation of other immune cells. Helpful during infection, it can also contribute to autoimmune disease, tissue damage, and wasting when produced excessively.

Tumor Necrosis Factor Receptor-Associated Periodic Syndrome

A rare inherited autoinflammatory disorder caused by variants in the TNFRSF1A gene, producing recurrent prolonged fever, muscle pain, abdominal pain, rash, and inflammation.

Alternate Names:
TRAPS

Tumor Staging

The process of determining how large a cancer is and whether it has spread to nearby lymph nodes or distant organs. The results help guide treatment and estimate outlook.

Tumor Resection

The complete surgical removal or excision of a benign or malignant mass of tissue; see *Excision* and *Biopsy*.

Tumor Suppressor

A gene or protein that helps prevent abnormal cell growth by slowing cell division, repairing DNA damage, or removing damaged cells. Loss of this protection can contribute to cancer.

Tumor Suppressor Gene

A gene that helps prevent uncontrolled cell growth by slowing division, repairing DNA damage, or directing abnormal cells to die. If both copies or the gene's function are lost or disabled, cells may grow abnormally and cancer risk can increase.

Tumor-Suppressor Gene

A gene that helps prevent uncontrolled cell growth by slowing cell division, repairing damaged DNA, or removing abnormal cells. Loss of its protective function can increase the chance of cancer.

Tumour

An abnormal mass caused by uncontrolled or inappropriate cell growth; it may be noncancerous or cancerous.

Tungiasis

A skin infestation caused by the sand flea Tunga penetrans, producing an itchy or painful lesion, usually on the feet.

Tunica Adventitia

The tough outer layer of a blood vessel. It contains supportive tissue, nerves, and small vessels and helps anchor the vessel to nearby structures.

Tunica Albuginea

A tough layer of connective tissue surrounding the testis. It helps protect the testicular tissue and sends inward partitions that divide it into lobules.

Tunica Media

The middle layer of a blood-vessel wall, made mainly of muscle and elastic tissue. It can tighten or relax to change vessel width and help control blood pressure and blood flow.

Tunica Vaginalis

A thin, slippery covering around most of the testis, formed from the abdominal lining during testicular descent. It allows the testis to move smoothly inside the scrotum.

Tunnel Vision

Loss of peripheral visual field leaving a narrowed central field, caused by glaucoma, retinal disease, optic-nerve or brain lesions, severe hypoxia, or other conditions.

Turbinates

Curved structures inside the nose that warm, moisten, and filter breathed air. They contain bone covered by soft tissue and can swell during allergies, infection, or irritation and make nasal breathing difficult.

Turbinate Hypertrophy

Enlargement or swelling of the nasal turbinates, the structures that warm and moisten inhaled air. It may be temporary or persistent, often with rhinitis or other nasal inflammation, and can narrow the nasal airway.

Alternate Names:
Hypertrophy of Nasal Turbinates; Turbinates Hypertrophy

Turbinate Surgery

An operation that reduces or reshapes swollen tissues along the side walls of the nose to improve airflow. It may help persistent nasal blockage when other treatment fails; bleeding, crusting, dryness, scarring, or ongoing obstruction are possible.

Turcot Syndrome

A rare inherited cancer-predisposition pattern involving colon polyps or colon cancer together with a brain tumor. It can result from mismatch-repair gene changes or the APC gene change seen in familial adenomatous polyposis, so genetic counseling and screening are important.

Alternate Names:
Brain Tumor-Polyposis Syndrome

Turf Toe

A sprain of the plantar capsuloligamentous structures at the base of the great toe, around the first metatarsophalangeal joint. It usually occurs when the toe is forced upward while the foot is fixed, stretching or tearing these tissues. Pain, swelling, and reduced push-off strength may occur; severity ranges from a mild sprain to complete tissue rupture.

Turgor

The firmness and springiness of body tissue caused partly by its fluid content. Skin that remains tented after being gently pinched may suggest dehydration, but this sign is not reliable by itself.

Turner Hypoplasia

A defect in the enamel of a permanent tooth caused by infection or injury involving the baby tooth above it. The affected tooth may have a discolored, rough, or weakened area.

Turner's Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Turner Syndrome*.

Turner Syndrome

A chromosome condition in which one X chromosome is missing or changed in some or all cells. The most common pattern is one X chromosome in each cell (45,X); mosaic forms have some cells with one X chromosome and others with two sex chromosomes. Features vary and may include short stature, ovaries that make few eggs or hormones, delayed puberty, reduced fertility, heart or kidney differences, hearing loss, or thyroid disease. Intelligence is usually typical, though some have specific learning difficulties.

Alternate Names:
45,X; Monosomy X; XO Syndrome; Ullrich-Turner Syndrome; Turner's Syndrome

Turner-Varny Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Turner Syndrome*.

Turning Patients Over In Bed

Repositioning a patient at planned intervals to protect skin, improve comfort and breathing, prevent pressure injuries and contractures, and reduce complications of immobility.

Turpentine Oil Poisoning

Poisoning from swallowing or inhaling turpentine oil. It can irritate or damage the lungs, stomach, and nervous system and may cause chemical pneumonia.

Tussis

Cough; a forceful reflex expiration that helps clear secretions, irritants, or foreign material from the

airways.

TVS

TVS commonly means transvaginal sonography, an ultrasound examination using a probe in the vagina to assess pelvic organs and early pregnancy.

T Wave

The part of an ECG that shows the heart's lower chambers resetting electrically after each beat. Changes in its height or direction can occur with reduced blood flow, abnormal body salts, heart strain, or other conditions.

T-Wave Alternans

T-wave alternans is a beat-to-beat change in the size or shape of the heart's T wave and may indicate increased risk of dangerous ventricular rhythms.

Twin

One of two offspring produced simultaneously by the same pregnancy. Biologically classified as monozygotic (identical twins, arising from the cleavage of a single fertilized ovum sharing identical genetic material) or dizygotic (fraternal twins, resulting from the fertilization of two distinct ova by two separate spermatozoa). Placentation varies in monozygotic twins depending on timing of embryonic splitting (dichorionic-diamniotic, monochorionic-diamniotic, or monochorionic-monoamniotic); monochorionic twin gestations carry specific risks of twin-to-twin transfusion syndrome (TTTS) and twin anemia-polycythemia sequence (TAPS).

Alternate Names:
Twins; Twin Gestation

Twin Placenta

The number and arrangement of placentas and the sacs surrounding twins. Knowing whether twins share a placenta or a sac helps estimate risks and determines how closely the pregnancy is monitored.

Twin Pregnancy

A pregnancy involving two fetuses. Clinical risk depends on chorionicity and amnionicity, with increased risks including preterm birth, fetal growth problems, and hypertensive disorders.

Twins

Plural form; see *Twin*.

Twin-To-Twin Transfusion Syndrome

A serious complication of an identical-twin pregnancy in which shared placental blood vessels send too much blood to one twin and too little to the other. It can cause anemia and growth restriction in one twin and heart strain or excess fluid in the other.

Twin Twin Transfusion Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Twin-To-Twin Transfusion Syndrome*.

Twin-Twin Transfusion Syndrome

A complication of an identical-twin pregnancy sharing one placenta, in which blood flows unevenly between the twins. One twin may receive too little blood and fluid, while the other receives too much, causing anemia, growth restriction, or heart strain.

Twitch

A brief involuntary muscle contraction or movement, which may be benign, medication-related, stress-related, or a sign of nerve, muscle, or brain disease.

Twitching

Repeated involuntary muscle contractions or fasciculations, commonly caused by fatigue, stimulants, electrolyte disturbance, nerve irritation, medicines, or neurologic disease.

Tympanic

Tympanic means relating to the eardrum or middle ear, or resembling a drum in shape or sound.

Tympanic Bulla

The tympanic bulla is a hollow or expanded bony chamber surrounding the middle ear, especially prominent in many mammals.

Tympanic Cavity

The air-filled chamber of the middle ear. It contains the eardrum and three tiny bones that transmit sound vibrations toward the inner ear, while a passage to the throat helps equalize air pressure.

Tympanic Hyperectasis

Abnormal bulging or stretching of the eardrum, usually related to long-lasting pressure changes in the middle ear. It may cause blocked-ear sensations or reduced hearing.

Tympanic Membrane

The thin eardrum separating the outer ear canal from the middle ear. Sound makes it vibrate, and those vibrations move the middle-ear bones; infection, injury, or pressure can tear it.

Tympanic Membrane Perforation

A tear or hole in the eardrum caused by infection, injury, pressure changes, or an object entering the ear. It may cause pain, drainage, or hearing loss.

Tympanites

Abdominal distension caused by excessive gas in the stomach or intestines, producing a drum-like sound on percussion and sometimes pain, belching, or altered bowel movements.

Tympanometer

An instrument that changes pressure in the ear canal and measures movement of the tympanic membrane and middle-ear system. It is used to perform tympanometry.

Tympanometry

An objective test that varies air pressure in the ear canal while measuring movement of the tympanic membrane and middle-ear pressure. It helps assess middle-ear fluid, eustachian-tube dysfunction, perforation, and ossicular or tympanic-membrane abnormalities.

Tympanoplasty

Surgical repair or reconstruction of the tympanic membrane and, when necessary, the middle-ear ossicles to close a perforation or improve hearing.

Tympanosclerosis

White, scar-like patches on the eardrum or in the middle ear, often left after repeated infections or inflammation. They usually cause no symptoms but can sometimes reduce hearing.

Alternate Names:
Myringosclerosis; Tympanic Membrane Calcification

Tympanostomy Tube Insertion

A procedure in which a small tube is placed through an incision in the eardrum to ventilate the middle ear and help prevent fluid from collecting behind it. It is used for selected cases of persistent middle-ear fluid or recurrent ear infections; the tube usually comes out on its own as the eardrum heals.

Alternate Names:
Ear Tube Insertion; Grommet Insertion; Myringotomy with Tube Insertion; Tympanostomy

Tympanostomy Tubes

Small tubes placed through the eardrum to let air into the middle ear and help fluid drain. They are used for repeated ear infections or persistent fluid causing hearing problems; drainage, blockage, scarring, or early tube loss can occur.

Tympanum

The middle-ear cavity or, in some contexts, the tympanic membrane.

Tympany

Tympany is a drumlike sound on percussion, often produced by gas in a hollow organ such as the stomach or intestine.

Tyndall Effect

The optical scattering of light by suspended inflammatory cells and proteinaceous exudate ('aqueous flare') in the anterior chamber of the eye viewed with a narrow slit-lamp biomicroscope beam against a dark background, serving as a cardinal physical

sign of active anterior uveitis (iritis / iridocyclitis).

Alternate Names:
Aqueous Flare; Anterior Chamber Tyndall Phenomenon

Type 1 Diabetes

A chronic autoimmune disease in which the body's immune system mistakenly attacks and destroys the insulin-producing beta cells in the pancreas. Without insulin, the body cannot move sugar from the bloodstream into cells for energy, causing glucose to build up in the blood while cells starve. It typically develops in children, teens, or young adults and presents with increased thirst, frequent urination, constant hunger, rapid weight loss, and extreme fatigue, requiring lifelong daily insulin to survive.

Alternate Names:
T1D; Type 1 Diabetes Mellitus; Insulin-Dependent Diabetes; IDDM

Type 1 Diabetes In Children

Type 1 diabetes diagnosed during childhood, usually caused by immune destruction of insulin-producing pancreatic beta cells. It causes absolute insulin deficiency and requires insulin treatment. Diabetic ketoacidosis, a potentially life-threatening complication, may be the first sign of the disease.

Type 1 Diabetes Mellitus

Type 1 diabetes is an autoimmune disease in which the immune system attacks and destroys the insulin-producing beta cells of the pancreas, resulting in absolute insulin deficiency.

Type 2 Diabetes

A chronic metabolic disorder characterized by high levels of glucose (sugar) in the bloodstream. It occurs when the body's cells become resistant to insulin—the hormone produced by the pancreas that allows cells to absorb and use sugar for energy—and the pancreas gradually loses its ability to produce enough insulin to compensate. Over time, chronically elevated blood sugar levels can damage blood vessels and nerves throughout the body, increasing the risk of cardiovascular disease, kidney damage, vision loss, and nerve problems.

Alternate Names:
T2D; Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus; Non-Insulin-Dependent Diabetes; NIDDM

Type 2 Diabetes In Children

Type 2 diabetes beginning during childhood or adolescence, often involving insulin resistance and requiring lifestyle and medical management.

Type 2 Diabetes Meal Planning

Nutritional guidance focusing on consistent carbohydrate intake, portion control, dietary fiber, lean proteins, and healthy fats to maintain target blood glucose and body weight.

Alternate Names:
Diabetic Meal Planning; Nutritional Therapy for Type 2 Diabetes; Diabetic Diet Plan

Type 2 Diabetes Medications

Alternate name; see *Oral Antidiabetic Agents*.

Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus

Alternate name; see *Type 2 Diabetes*.

Type 3B Diabetes

Type 3b diabetes is a form of diabetes caused by disease or removal of the pancreas, which can impair both insulin and digestive-enzyme production.

Type Ia Glycogen Storage Disease

Von Gierke disease, caused by glucose-6-phosphatase deficiency. It typically causes severe fasting hypoglycemia, lactic acidosis, hyperlipidemia, hyperuricemia, hepatomegaly, and impaired growth.

Type Ib Glycogen Storage Disease

A glycogen-storage disorder caused by impaired glucose-6-phosphate transport in the endoplasmic reticulum. It can cause fasting hypoglycemia, lactic acidosis, hepatomegaly, neutropenia, recurrent infections, and inflammatory bowel disease.

Type I Hypersensitivity

A rapid allergic reaction in which the immune system releases substances such as histamine after ex-

posure to an allergen. It can cause hay fever, asthma symptoms, hives, food allergy, or life-threatening anaphylaxis.

Type II Hypersensitivity

An immune reaction in which antibodies attach to a person's cells or tissues and cause injury or destruction. It contributes to some blood-cell disorders, medicine reactions, and autoimmune diseases.

Type III GSD (Forbes-Cori)

An inherited glycogen-storage disorder caused by debranching-enzyme deficiency. It can cause fasting hypoglycemia, hepatomegaly, muscle weakness, elevated liver enzymes, and sometimes cardiomyopathy, with severity varying by subtype.

Type III Hypersensitivity

An immune reaction in which clusters of antibodies and foreign or abnormal proteins settle in tissues and trigger inflammation. It can damage the skin, joints, blood vessels, kidneys, or other organs.

Type III Hypersensitivity Reaction

Tissue injury caused when antigen-antibody clusters deposit in tissues and activate inflammation. This reaction can damage blood vessels, joints, kidneys, skin, or other organs, as in serum sickness or lupus.

Type II Muscle Fiber

A fast-contracting muscle fiber that can produce high force quickly but usually tires sooner than a type I fiber.

Type I Muscle Fiber

A slow-contracting muscle fiber that uses oxygen efficiently and can keep working for a long time. It is important for posture and endurance.

Type IV GSD (Andersen)

An inherited disorder caused by branching-enzyme deficiency, leading to abnormal glycogen accumulation. Progressive liver disease, cirrhosis, growth problems, muscle disease, or neuromuscular involvement may occur.

Type IV Hypersensitivity

A delayed immune reaction driven mainly by T cells rather than antibodies. It usually develops hours to days after exposure and can cause contact dermatitis, some medicine reactions, or inflammation in an organ.

Types Of Ileostomy

Types of ileostomy include end, loop, and continent procedures, which divert stool through an opening in the abdominal wall when the colon or rectum cannot be used normally.

Type V Glycogen Storage Disease

An inherited muscle disorder, also called McArdle disease, in which muscle cells cannot properly break down glycogen for energy. Exercise can cause muscle pain, cramps, and sometimes dark urine from muscle injury.

Type VI Glycogen Storage Disease

Hers disease, caused by hepatic glycogen-phosphorylase deficiency. It usually causes mild fasting hypoglycemia, hepatomegaly, growth delay, and elevated liver enzymes, with symptoms often improving with age.

Type VII Glycogen Storage Disease

Tarui disease, caused by phosphofructokinase deficiency in muscle and red blood cells. Exercise intolerance, muscle cramps, rhabdomyolysis, and hemolytic anemia may occur, sometimes with a second-wind phenomenon.

Typhlitis

A serious infection and inflammation of the first part of the large intestine, usually in someone with very low white-cell counts after cancer treatment. It can cause right-sided abdominal pain, fever, diarrhea, bowel damage, perforation, or sepsis.

Alternate Names:
Neutropenic Enterocolitis; Ileocecal Syndrome; Cecitis

Typhoid

Alternate name; see *Typhoid Fever*.

Typhoid Fever

A serious infection caused by *Salmonella enterica* serovar Typhi, usually spread through food or water contaminated with infected stool. It can cause a gradually worsening fever, headache, tiredness, and abdominal symptoms; some people develop a faint rash. Severe illness may cause intestinal bleeding or perforation. Blood culture is the main diagnostic test, and antibiotic choice depends on resistance patterns.

Alternate Names:
Enteric Fever; Salmonella Typhi Infection; Typhoid

Typhus

A group of bacterial infections spread mainly by lice, fleas, or mites. They can cause fever, headache, rash, and serious illness affecting several organs; the type and treatment depend on the bacteria and insect involved.

Typhus Fever

A group of bacterial infections spread by lice, fleas, or mites. They commonly cause sudden fever, severe headache, weakness, and sometimes rash or organ injury; the exact illness determines testing and antibiotic treatment.

Typical Antipsychotics

Older antipsychotic medicines used for conditions such as psychosis, mania, or severe agitation. They can reduce hallucinations and delusions but may cause stiffness, tremor, involuntary movements, sleepiness, or other serious effects.

Tyramine

A naturally occurring amine found in some aged or fermented foods. In people taking monoamine oxidase inhibitors, excessive tyramine can cause a dangerous rise in blood pressure.

Tyrosine

An amino acid used to build proteins and make thyroid hormones, melanin, and adrenaline-like chemicals. The body usually makes enough from phenylalanine, but inherited metabolic disorders can disrupt this pathway.

Alternate Names:
L-Tyrosine; 4-Hydroxyphenylalanine; Tyr

Tyrosine Kinase Inhibitors

A major class of targeted antineoplastic pharmacological agents that competitively inhibit the adenosine triphosphate-binding catalytic pocket of tyrosine kinase enzymes, blocking downstream oncogenic proliferative signaling cascades (e.g., imatinib for BCR-ABL, osimertinib for EGFR).

Alternate Names:
TKIs

Tyrosinemia

An inherited disorder in which the body cannot break down the amino acid tyrosine normally. Harmful substances can build up and damage the liver, kidneys, nerves, or eyes; severity depends on the type and treatment.

Tzanck Smear

A microscope test of cells scraped from a blister or sore. It may suggest a herpes infection or pemphigus, but it cannot reliably identify the cause and is often replaced by more specific laboratory tests.

U

UA (Urinalysis)

UA commonly means urinalysis, laboratory examination of urine for blood, protein, cells, glucose, infection, and other findings.

Ubiquitin-Proteasome System

A cell system that marks selected proteins with ubiquitin and breaks them down in the proteasome. It removes damaged or unneeded proteins and helps regulate cell processes.

Alternate Names:
UPS; Ubiquitin-Proteasome Pathway

UBT (Urea Breath Test)

UBT commonly means urea breath test, which detects active Helicobacter pylori infection by measuring labeled carbon dioxide after ingested urea.

UDP-Glucuronosyltransferase

A group of enzymes, found mainly in the liver, that helps the body process and remove bilirubin, medicines, hormones, and other substances. Inherited differences in these enzymes can cause some types of jaundice or change how medicines work.

UDP-Glucuronosyltransferase Deficiency

Reduced activity of a liver enzyme that prepares bilirubin for removal from the body. Inherited deficiency can cause intermittent mild jaundice or, in severe forms, dangerous bilirubin buildup.

UGIB

Abbreviation; see *Upper Gastrointestinal Bleeding*.

Uhl Anomaly

A rare heart defect present from birth in which much of the muscle of the right lower chamber is missing. The chamber may pump poorly, causing blue coloring, abnormal rhythms, or heart failure in infancy or childhood.

Uhthoff Phenomenon

Temporary worsening of old neurologic symptoms, especially vision problems, when a person with multiple sclerosis becomes overheated from exercise, fever, or a hot bath. Symptoms usually improve as the body cools.

Alternate Names:
Uhthoff Sign

Ulcer

An open sore caused by loss of the surface layers of skin or a mucous membrane, sometimes extending into deeper tissue. Causes include poor blood flow, pressure, infection, nerve damage, inflammation, injury, and cancer.

Ulceration

The formation of an open sore caused by loss of surface tissue, usually involving skin or a mucous membrane and sometimes extending into deeper tissue.

Ulcerative Colitis

A chronic inflammatory bowel disease that causes ongoing inflammation and tiny sores (ulcers) in the innermost lining of the large intestine (colon) and rectum. Unlike Crohn's disease, which can affect any part of the digestive tract and penetrate deep tissue

layers, ulcerative colitis is confined to the colon and rectum and affects only the surface mucosal lining. It typically causes recurrent bouts of bloody diarrhea, crampy abdominal pain, an urgent need to empty the bowels, and fatigue.

Alternate Names:
UC; Idiopathic Proctocolitis; Inflammatory Bowel Disease (Ulcerative Colitis)

Ulcerative Colitis Pathology

Chronic, usually continuous mucosal inflammation beginning in the rectum and extending proximally. Findings include crypt architectural distortion, cryptitis, crypt abscesses, mucosal ulceration, and inflammatory polyps in active or longstanding disease.

Ulcerative Colitis (UC)

Alternate name; see *Ulcerative Colitis*.

Ulcerative Keratitis

An open sore or defect in the cornea, the clear front surface of the eye. It may result from infection, injury, or inflammation and can cause pain, redness, light sensitivity, and blurred vision.

Ulcerative Proctitis

Inflammation and ulceration limited to the lining of the rectum, often causing rectal bleeding, urgency, tenesmus, mucus, and diarrhea.

Ulcer Healing Drugs

Medicines that help heal gastrointestinal ulcers, usually by reducing stomach acid or protecting the stomach lining. The choice depends on the ulcer's cause, such as *H. pylori* infection or use of nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs.

Ulerythema

A historical term for redness and scarring associated with follicular disorders. It commonly refers to ulerythema ophryogenes, also called keratosis pilaris atrophicans faciei, which causes inflamed follicular bumps around the eyebrows and cheeks. Chronic inflammation can produce small scars and loss of eyebrow hair.

Ullrich Congenital Muscular Dystrophy

An inherited muscle disease caused by problems with collagen VI, a protein that supports muscle and connective tissue. It begins in infancy with weakness, low muscle tone, tight joints near the body, unusually loose joints in the hands and feet, and later breathing problems.

Alternate Names:
UCMD; Ullrich Scleroatonic Muscular Dystrophy

Ulna

The forearm bone on the side of the little finger. Its upper end forms most of the hinge of the elbow, and its lower end helps form the wrist. Together with the radius, it supports rotation of the forearm and movement of the hand.

Ulnar

Relating to the ulna or to the side of the forearm and hand nearest the little finger. Compression or injury of the ulnar nerve can cause tingling or numbness in the little finger and part of the ring finger.

Ulnar Artery

A major artery running along the little-finger side of the forearm and into the hand. It supplies blood to the forearm and hand and helps form the hand's arterial arches.

Ulnar Claw Hand

A hand posture caused by severe ulnar nerve injury, usually at the wrist. The ring and little fingers bend at their middle and end joints and straighten unusually at the knuckles because small hand muscles are weak or paralyzed.

Alternate Names:
Duchenne Sign; Duchenne Claw Hand

Ulnar Collateral Ligament

A strong ligament on the inner side of the elbow that helps stabilize the joint when the forearm is forced outward. Repeated throwing can stretch or tear it.

Alternate Names:

UCL of the Elbow; Medial Collateral Ligament of Elbow

Ulnar Deviation

Angling of the hand or fingers toward the ulna, the bone on the little-finger side of the forearm. Ulnar deviation of the fingers at the knuckles can occur in rheumatoid arthritis when joint and tendon support is damaged.

Alternate Names:
Ulnar Drift

Ulnar Drift

Alternate name; see *Ulnar Deviation*.

Ulnar Hypoplasia

Underdevelopment or partial absence of the ulna, the forearm bone on the little-finger side. Present from birth in most cases, it may shorten or bend the forearm, limit elbow or wrist movement, and occur with finger or other body differences.

Ulnar Nerve

A nerve running from the neck through the inner arm and behind the elbow to the hand. It controls some hand and forearm muscles and carries feeling from the little finger and part of the ring finger.

Ulnar Nerve Dysfunction

Alternate name; see *Ulnar Neuropathy*.

Ulnar Nerve Entrapment

Alternate name; see *Ulnar Neuropathy*.

Ulnar Neuropathy

Damage or pressure on the ulnar nerve, most often at the elbow or wrist. It can cause numbness or tingling in the little finger and part of the ring finger, weak grip, or difficulty spreading the fingers.

Alternate Names:
Ulnar Nerve Entrapment; Ulnar Nerve Dysfunction

Ulnar Neuropathy at Guyon Canal

Compression of the ulnar nerve as it passes through Guyon canal at the wrist. It can cause numbness in the little finger and part of the ring finger, weakness of small hand muscles, or both, depending on which nerve branches are affected.

Alternate Names:
Guyon Canal Syndrome; Handlebar Palsy; Ulnar Tunnel Syndrome

Ulnar Paradox

The apparently unexpected finding that damage to the ulnar nerve at the wrist can cause more clawing of the fingers than damage higher in the arm. The difference occurs because some finger-bending muscles remain active after a wrist injury.

Ulnar-Sided Wrist Pain

Alternate name; see *Ulnar Wrist Pain*.

Ulnar Tunnel Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Ulnar Neuropathy at Guyon Canal*.

Ulnar Vein

Veins on the little-finger side of the forearm that carry blood away from the forearm and hand. They join other deep veins near the elbow to continue toward the heart.

Ulnar Wrist Pain

Pain on the side of the wrist nearest the little finger, often involving the ulna or nearby tendons and ligaments.

Alternate Names:
Ulnar-Sided Wrist Pain

Ultrafiltration

A process in which pressure pushes water and small dissolved substances through a very fine filter while larger particles remain behind. The kidneys use it to begin forming urine, and dialysis uses it to remove excess fluid.

Ultra-processed food

Ultra-processed food is an industrially formulated product made mostly from refined ingredients and additives, often with little intact whole food. Fre-

quent high intake is associated with poorer health outcomes, although effects vary by the food and overall diet.

Ultrasonic Therapy

Treatment using high-frequency sound energy to heat, move, break up, or otherwise affect tissue. It is used in selected physical-therapy procedures and some operations; benefits and risks depend on the device, body site, and condition.

Ultrasonography

Alternate name; see *Ultrasound*.

Ultrasound

An imaging test that uses high-frequency sound waves to show organs, blood vessels, tissues, or a developing fetus without ionizing radiation. Different examinations can assess the abdomen, pelvis, kidneys, thyroid, heart, blood flow, or testicles.

Ultrasound Biomicroscopy

Very high-frequency ultrasound that creates detailed images of the front part of the eye, including the cornea, iris, lens, and drainage angle when an ordinary eye examination is not enough.

Ultrasound Contrast

Tiny gas-filled bubbles given into a vein to improve ultrasound images of blood flow and selected organs. They are usually cleared through the lungs but can rarely cause allergic or cardiopulmonary reactions.

Ultrasound-Guided Biopsy

A procedure in which ultrasound images guide a needle into an area of concern to collect cells or tissue for testing. It can be used for lumps or abnormal areas in organs such as the breast, thyroid, liver, or lymph nodes.

Ultrasound-Guided Breast Biopsy

A procedure that uses ultrasound images to guide a needle into a breast abnormality and collect tissue for examination. The needle may remove a small core or, with a vacuum-assisted device, a larger sample.

Alternate Names:
Sonographically Guided Breast Biopsy; Ultrasound Breast Biopsy

Ultrasound Scan

Alternate name; see *Ultrasound*.

Ultrasound Therapy

Use of sound waves at therapeutic intensity to heat or mechanically affect tissue. It is used in selected rehabilitation settings, but evidence and suitability vary by condition.

Ultrasound Transducer

The probe placed against the skin or inside a body opening during an ultrasound scan. It sends and receives sound waves to create images or guide a procedure; different probes are used for different body areas.

Ultraviolet Rays

Invisible electromagnetic radiation with wavelengths shorter than visible violet light. Excess exposure can cause sunburn, photoaging, eye injury, and skin cancers; controlled ultraviolet exposure has selected therapeutic uses.

Ultraviolet Therapy

Controlled exposure to ultraviolet light used for selected skin disorders such as psoriasis, eczema, and vitiligo; risks include burns, premature skin aging, and skin cancer.

Umbilical

Relating to the umbilicus or navel, including structures, lesions, discharge, or abnormalities located at or connected with it.

Umbilical Artery Catheter

A thin tube placed through an umbilical artery in a newborn and advanced into a large artery. It allows continuous blood-pressure monitoring and blood sampling; complications include infection, bleeding, and impaired blood flow to the legs or bowel.

Alternate Names:
UAC

Umbilical Artery Doppler

An ultrasound measurement of blood flow through the umbilical cord. It helps assess how well the placenta is supplying the fetus, especially when fetal growth is reduced or pregnancy complications affect placental function.

Umbilical Catheters

Umbilical catheters provide vascular access through a newborn's umbilical vessels for fluids, medicines, monitoring, or blood sampling while complications are monitored.

Umbilical Cord

The connection between a fetus and the placenta. It contains blood vessels that carry oxygen, nutrients, and waste between them and is protected by a soft, cushioning tissue.

Umbilical Cord Blood Gas

A test of blood taken from the umbilical cord after birth to assess the baby's oxygen supply and acid-base balance around delivery. Arterial and venous results provide different information and must be interpreted with the baby's condition, gestational age, and delivery circumstances.

Umbilical Cord Complications

Problems involving the umbilical cord, including prolapse, compression, knots, abnormal insertion, short or long cord, and vascular abnormalities. They may reduce fetal oxygenation or complicate delivery.

Umbilical Cord Compression

Mechanical obstruction of blood flow through the umbilical vessels caused by pressure from the fetal presenting part, uterine contractions, or cord entanglement, characteristically manifesting as variable decelerations on fetal heart rate monitoring.

Umbilical Cord Prolapse

The umbilical cord slips through the cervix ahead of or alongside the baby, usually after the waters break. The cord can be squeezed and reduce the baby's oxygen supply, making this an obstetric emergency.

Umbilical Granuloma

A small, moist, pink or red nodule of granulation tissue at a newborn's navel after the umbilical cord separates. Persistent discharge, inflammation, or infection may indicate another condition, such as an abnormal connection to the bladder or intestine.

Alternate Names:
Granuloma Umbilicale; Neonatal Umbilical Granuloma

Umbilical Hernia

A soft bulge caused when tissue pushes through the opening at the navel. Many infant hernias close as the child grows, while adult hernias may enlarge or become trapped and painful and sometimes need surgery.

Umbilical Region

The central part of the abdomen around the navel. Pain, swelling, a hernia, or a lump in this area may arise from the bowel, abdominal wall, blood vessels, or other organs.

Umbilical Vein

The umbilical vein carries oxygen- and nutrient-rich blood from the placenta to the fetus during pregnancy.

Umbilication

Formation of a central hollow or navel-like depression in a skin lesion or other body structure. It can occur in some infections, inflammatory lesions, tumors, or normal anatomical features and must be interpreted with the lesion's appearance.

Umbilicus

The navel, a scar on the front of the abdomen left after the umbilical cord separates at birth. It may be affected by a hernia, infection, discharge, or other skin changes.

Alternate Names:

Belly Button; Omphalos

Uncal Herniation

A life-threatening type of brain herniation in which pressure pushes part of the temporal lobe down against structures at the base of the brain. It can compress nerves and blood vessels, causing a large unreactive pupil, weakness, reduced consciousness, or brain injury.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Transtentorial Herniation; Uncinate Herniation

Uncal Transtentorial Herniation

Alternate name; see *Uncal Herniation*.

Unconjugated Hyperbilirubinemia

A higher-than-normal level of unconjugated (indirect) bilirubin in the blood. Causes include breakdown of red blood cells, reduced liver uptake, or difficulty converting bilirubin into a form that can be removed; in newborns, very high levels can harm the brain.

Unconscious

Not awake and not responsive to ordinary external stimuli. Unconsciousness may result from syncope, seizure, trauma, intoxication, metabolic disease, stroke, or other emergencies.

Unconsciousness

Loss of awareness and normal response to surroundings, ranging from brief fainting to prolonged coma. It can result from reduced brain blood flow, injury, seizures, low blood sugar, drugs, or serious illness.

Uncoupling Protein

A member of a family of proteins in the inner mitochondrial membrane that can reduce the coupling between energy production and ATP formation. UCP1, found in brown fat, dissipates this energy as heat; other family members have different or less fully understood roles.

Uncover Test

The uncover portion of an eye-alignment test in which an examiner watches the eyes as an occluder is removed. Movement of the previously covered eye as it resumes fixation indicates a latent deviation (phoria); movement of the other eye when the first is covered indicates manifest strabismus (tropia).

Underactive Thyroid

Alternate name; see *Hypothyroidism*.

Underventilation

Breathing that is too slow or shallow to remove enough carbon dioxide. It may also lower oxygen and can result from sedatives, weak breathing muscles, severe obesity, lung disease, or brain problems.

Underweight

Body weight below the expected range for a person's age and height. In adults, a body mass index below 18.5 is commonly classified as underweight; in children, growth charts and age-specific measures are used. Low weight may reflect body build, inadequate nutrition, illness, or unintentional weight loss.

Undescended Testicle

See *Cryptorchidism*.

Undescended Testicle Repair

An operation that moves a testicle into the scrotum and fixes it there. It is usually performed in childhood to support fertility, allow examination, and reduce risks related to twisting, injury, and cancer.

Undescended Testis

See *Cryptorchidism*.

Undifferentiated

Not showing the recognizable features of a specialized cell or tissue. An undifferentiated tumor has cells that look very unlike normal tissue, so its origin and behavior may be difficult to determine.

Undifferentiated Arthritis

Inflammatory arthritis with joint symptoms and signs that do not yet fit one specific named arthritis. The pattern may become clearer over time or remain an undifferentiated condition.

Undifferentiated Cancer

Cancer made of cells that look very unlike normal cells and do not clearly show the tissue where they began. Special laboratory tests and imaging may be needed to identify its type and guide treatment.

Undifferentiated Carcinoma

A high-grade carcinoma whose cells lack recognizable features of a specific tissue or tumor subtype; diagnosis and treatment require pathology, immunostaining, and staging.

Undifferentiated Connective Tissue Disease

An autoimmune connective-tissue disease with symptoms or laboratory findings suggesting systemic inflammation but not enough features for a specific diagnosis such as lupus or systemic sclerosis.

Undifferentiated Connective-Tissue Disease

Alternate name; see *Undifferentiated Connective Tissue Disease*.

Undifferentiated Pleomorphic Sarcoma

An uncommon, often fast-growing cancer of soft tissue or bone whose cells vary greatly in shape and do not resemble a specific normal tissue. Treatment depends on its site, size, and spread.

Alternate Names:
UPS; Malignant Fibrous Histiocytoma; MFH

Undifferentiated Pleomorphic Sarcoma Of The Breast

A rare high-grade breast sarcoma formerly called malignant fibrous histiocytoma. It is a diagnosis of exclusion after other specific sarcomas and metaplastic carcinoma have been ruled out histologically.

Undifferentiated Spondyloarthritis

Inflammatory arthritis with features of the spondyloarthritis group but insufficient or atypical findings for classification as ankylosing spondylitis, psoriatic arthritis, reactive arthritis, enteropathic arthritis, or another defined subtype. Symptoms may involve the spine, sacroiliac joints, peripheral joints, entheses, skin, eyes, or bowel.

Undulant Fever

An infection caused by *Brucella* bacteria, usually acquired from infected animals or unpasteurized dairy products. It can cause repeated or fluctuating fever, sweats, tiredness, joint pain, and serious organ complications.

Unerupted Tooth

A tooth that has not emerged into the oral cavity at the expected time. It may be normally developing, delayed, impacted, or prevented from erupting by obstruction or abnormal position.

Ungual

Relating to a fingernail or toenail. The term may describe a finding beneath, around, or within the nail, such as a bruise, fungal infection, wart, or pigmented lesion.

Unicameral Bone Cyst

A noncancerous, fluid-filled space in a bone, usually in the upper arm or thigh of a child or teenager. It may be found after a weakened bone breaks. A fallen-fragment sign on imaging can support the diagnosis, but it is not specific by itself.

Alternate Names:
Simple Bone Cyst; Solitary Bone Cyst

Unicornuate Uterus

A congenital condition in which only one side of the uterus develops fully, usually with one fallopian tube. Some people have no symptoms, but it can increase risks of infertility, pregnancy outside the uterus, miscarriage, or premature birth.

Unilateral

Affecting, occurring on, or involving one side of the body or one paired organ, such as unilateral weakness or unilateral eye disease.

Unilateral Gynecomastia

Enlargement of breast glandular tissue on one side in a male patient. It may be caused by hormonal changes, medicines, or an underlying disorder.

Unilateral Microphthalmos

A congenital condition in which one eye is abnormally small. It may be associated with other ocular malformations and can cause substantial visual impairment.

Unilateral Spatial Neglect

Reduced awareness of one side of the body or surrounding space, usually after a stroke or other brain injury. A person may fail to notice or respond to things on the side opposite the brain injury, even when basic vision and sensation are intact.

Alternate Names:
Hemispatial Neglect; Spatial Inattention

Uninodular Goiter

An enlarged thyroid containing one main lump, or nodule. Blood tests and ultrasound help assess thyroid function and cancer risk; nodules may be monitored or sampled according to their features.

Unintentional Weight Loss

Unintentional weight loss is reduction in body weight without planned dietary or activity change and may result from malignancy, endocrine disease, infection, gastrointestinal disease, medication, or mood disorder.

Uniparental Disomy

A chromosome difference in which both copies of a chromosome, or part of one, come from the same parent. It can cause disease by disrupting genes that depend on parental origin or by giving a child two copies of a harmful gene variant.

Universal Donor

A person with type O RhD-negative blood, whose red blood cells lack A, B, and RhD antigens. These red cells are often used for emergency transfusion when the recipient's blood type is not yet known, but they are not compatible with every possible red-cell antibody.

Alternate Names:
Type O Negative Donor; Universal Erythrocyte Donor

Universal Precautions

Older infection-control guidance for preventing exposure to bloodborne infections. It has been incorporated into broader Standard Precautions, which apply to all patients and include hand hygiene, protective equipment based on exposure risk, safe injections, and safe handling of equipment.

Universal Recipient

A person with type AB RhD-positive blood, whose red blood cells can generally receive red-cell transfusions of any ABO and RhD type. Other red-cell antigens can still affect compatibility, and this term does not apply to plasma transfusions.

Alternate Names:
Type AB Positive Recipient; Universal Red Cell Recipient; Universal RBC Recipient

Unloader Knee Brace

A knee brace designed to shift some load away from an affected compartment of the knee, often in osteoarthritis. It may be called a valgus or varus brace, depending on the direction of force.

Alternate Names:
Unloader Knee Braces; Unloader Knee Bracing; Offloader Knee Brace

Unopposed Estrogen

Estrogen exposure without enough progestogen to oppose its effect on the uterine lining. In a person with a uterus, prolonged exposure can cause endometrial overgrowth and increase the risk of endometrial cancer.

Unresectable

Describing a tumor or lesion that cannot be completely removed safely by surgery because of its location, extent, invasion of vital structures, or the patient's operative risk.

Unresponsive Coma

Alternate name; see *Coma*.

Unsaturated Fat

A dietary fat whose fatty-acid chains contain one or more carbon-carbon double bonds. Monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats are common in vegetable oils, nuts, seeds, and fish; replacing saturated fat with unsaturated fat generally supports healthier LDL cholesterol levels.

Unstable Angina

Chest pain caused by reduced blood flow to the heart that is new, worsening, lasts longer, or occurs at rest, without clear evidence of heart-muscle death. It is an emergency warning of possible heart attack.

Unsteadiness

Impaired balance or gait stability, which may result from vestibular disease, neurologic disorders, weakness, medication effects, visual impairment, or musculoskeletal problems.

Untidy Wound

An irregular or contaminated wound with crushing, devitalized tissue, tissue loss, foreign material, or associated injury to vessels, nerves, tendons, or bone. It has increased infection risk and may require exploration, irrigation, debridement, and delayed or staged closure.

Upper Airway Biopsy

Removal of tissue from the nasal cavity, pharynx, larynx, or related upper airway for microscopic evaluation of suspected infection, inflammation, infiltrative disease, or tumor.

Upper Airway Cough Syndrome

A possible cause of long-lasting cough associated with conditions of the nose or sinuses, such as allergies or chronic sinus inflammation. Nasal symptoms may occur, but the exact cause of the cough can be difficult to establish.

Alternate Names:
UACS

Upper Airway Obstruction

Narrowing or blockage of the breathing passage in the nose, throat, or voice box. It can cause noisy breathing, breathlessness, voice changes, or blue lips and can become life-threatening when severe or rapidly worsening.

Upper Airway Resistance Syndrome

An older term for sleep-disordered breathing in which increased effort to breathe through a narrowed upper airway causes repeated brief awakenings, often without meeting standard apnea or hypopnea thresholds. Current sleep classifications generally include this pattern within obstructive sleep apnea rather than treating it as a separate disorder.

Alternate Names:
UARS

Upper Arm

The portion of the upper limb between the shoulder and elbow, containing the humerus and muscles, nerves, and vessels that serve the arm.

Upper Endoscopy

A flexible camera examination of the food pipe, stomach, and first part of the small intestine. It can identify inflammation, ulcers, bleeding, narrowing, or tumors and can allow tissue samples or treatment.

Upper Esophageal Sphincter

A ring of muscle at the top of the esophagus that opens during swallowing and coordinates food passage.

Alternate Names:
UES

Upper Extremity

The anatomic region extending from the shoulder

through the arm, forearm, wrist, and hand. Disorders may involve its bones, joints, muscles, nerves, vessels, or skin.

Upper Extremity Deep Vein Thrombosis

A thrombosis occurring in the deep venous system of the arm or thoracic inlet (axillary, subclavian, or brachiocephalic veins), categorized as primary (effort-induced venous thrombosis or Paget-Schroetter syndrome) or secondary (most commonly related to indwelling central venous catheters or pacemaker leads).

Alternate Names:
UEDVT

Upper Extremity Venous Doppler

An ultrasound examination of the arm and related veins that assesses compressibility and blood flow, commonly to evaluate suspected venous thrombosis.

Upper Gastrointestinal Bleeding

Bleeding from the esophagus, stomach, or first part of the small intestine. It may cause vomiting of red or coffee-ground blood, black stools, dizziness, weakness, or fainting. Common causes include ulcers, inflammation, tears, and enlarged veins; significant bleeding can be life-threatening.

Alternate Names:
UGIB; Upper GI Bleed; Upper GI Hemorrhage

Upper GI And Small Bowel Series

A fluoroscopic x-ray examination in which swallowed contrast outlines the esophagus, stomach, duodenum, and small intestine to evaluate structure and transit.

Upper GI Series

An X-ray examination of the food pipe, stomach, and first part of the small intestine after swallowing contrast material. It can show narrowing, blockage, ulcers, abnormal movement, or other structural problems.

Upper Leg

The portion of the lower limb between the hip and knee, containing the femur and the thigh muscles, nerves, and blood vessels.

Upper Limb Disorders

Conditions affecting the shoulder, arm, elbow, forearm, wrist, or hand, including musculoskeletal, nerve, vascular, and work-related disorders.

Upper Motor Neuron

A motor neuron with its cell body in the brain or brainstem that sends signals to lower motor neurons in the brainstem or spinal cord. Damage to these pathways can cause weakness, stiffness, exaggerated reflexes, or difficulty controlling movement.

Upper Motor Neuron Lesion

Damage to movement pathways in the brain or spinal cord. It can cause weakness, increased muscle tone, exaggerated reflexes, spasms, or an abnormal plantar reflex; findings depend on the site and extent of injury.

Alternate Names:
Pyramidal Tract Lesion

Upper Motor Neuron Syndrome

A group of findings caused by damage to movement pathways in the brain or spinal cord. It may cause weakness, stiffness, muscle spasms, exaggerated reflexes, or reduced control of movement.

Upper Respiratory Infection

Alternate name; see *Upper Respiratory Tract Infection*.

Upper Respiratory Tract Infection

An infection of the nose, sinuses, throat, or voice box, most often caused by a virus. Examples include the common cold, rhinitis, pharyngitis, tonsillitis, and sinusitis.

Alternate Names:
URTI; Upper Respiratory Infection; URI

Upper Tract Urothelial Carcinoma

Tumors arising from the urothelial lining of the upper urinary tract. Blood in the urine, flank pain, ob-

struction, or incidental imaging findings may occur; urine cytology, imaging, ureteroscopy, and tissue assessment guide diagnosis and treatment.

Upper-Tract Urothelial Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Upper Tract Urothelial Carcinoma*.

Upright Labor Positions

Maternal positions during labor, such as walking, standing, squatting, kneeling, or sitting upright. They may improve comfort and mobility and can be used when safe and acceptable to the laboring person and clinical team.

Upward Gaze

Elevation of both eyes to direct the visual axis upward. It depends on coordinated activity of the extraocular muscles and their brainstem control pathways.

Urachal Abnormalities

Birth-related problems caused by incomplete closure of the urachus, the temporary fetal connection between the bladder and navel. They include a urachal cyst, sinus, or open connection and may cause infection, navel discharge, abdominal pain, or urine leakage.

Urachal Carcinoma

A rare cancer arising from a leftover connection between the bladder and the navel, usually near the top of the bladder. It may cause blood or mucus in the urine, pelvic pain, or urinary changes.

Urachal Cyst

A fluid-filled sac left from the temporary fetal connection between the bladder and navel. It may cause no symptoms, but infection can produce lower-abdominal pain, fever, navel discharge, or urinary symptoms.

Urachal Fistula

A persistent passage between the bladder and navel that results from incomplete closure of the urachus before birth. It can cause urine to leak from the navel.

Alternate Names:
Patent Urachus; Persistent Urachal Canal

Urachal Mucinous Cystic Tumor

A rare mucin-producing cystic tumor arising from urachal tissue between the bladder and navel. It includes lesions ranging from benign tumors and tumors of low malignant potential to invasive adenocarcinoma. Tissue examination distinguishes these categories and establishes whether invasion is present.

Urachus

An embryologic connection between the fetal bladder and umbilicus that normally becomes the median umbilical ligament after birth. Persistent urachal remnants can form cysts, sinuses, or other complications.

Uracil-DNA Glycosylase

A DNA repair enzyme that initiates the base excision repair (BER) pathway by specifically recognizing and hydrolyzing the N-glycosidic bond of mutagenic uracil residues formed by spontaneous deamination of cytosine in DNA, generating an abasic (AP) site for downstream repair.

Alternate Names:
UDG

Uraemia

Alternate spelling; see *Uremia*.

Uraemic Foetor

Alternate spelling; see *Uremic Fetor*.

Uraemic Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Uremia*.

Uranium

A naturally occurring radioactive heavy metal. Internal exposure can damage the kidneys, while inhaled or retained radioactive material can also expose tissues to ionizing radiation.

Urate

The ionized salt or anion of uric acid formed under physiologic pH conditions in human plasma and extracellular fluids. Generated as the end product of purine nucleotide metabolism via the hepatic enzyme xanthine oxidase, circulating urate is primarily eliminated via renal excretion (70%) and the gastrointestinal tract (30%). Elevated serum urate levels exceeding the physiologic solubility limit (> 6.8 mg/dL) cause hyperuricemia, precipitating the precipitation and deposition of needle-shaped, negatively birefringent monosodium urate (MSU) crystals in joints and periarticular soft tissues (gouty arthritis and tophi) or the renal collecting system (uric acid nephrolithiasis).

Alternate Names:
Urates; Monosodium Urate; Uric Acid Salt

Urate-Lowering Therapy

Long-term treatment that lowers urate in the blood, helping dissolve gout crystals and prevent further attacks and joint damage. The medicine is chosen according to kidney function, other illnesses, and treatment goals.

Urate Nephropathy

Kidney injury caused by uric acid or urate crystals collecting in the kidney's small tubes. It can occur when uric acid rises rapidly, such as during tumor lysis syndrome, and may reduce kidney function.

Alternate Names:
Acute Uric Acid Nephropathy; Crystal-Induced Urate Nephropathy

Urates

Plural form; see *Urate*.

Urea

The principal nitrogen-containing waste product of protein metabolism, formed in the liver and excreted mainly by the kidneys.

Urea Breath Test

A noninvasive test for active Helicobacter pylori infection: the person drinks labeled urea, and labeled carbon dioxide in exhaled breath indicates bacterial urease activity.

Urea Cycle

A series of chemical reactions in the liver that changes toxic ammonia, produced when the body breaks down protein, into urea. The kidneys then remove urea in urine.

Urea Cycle Disorder

An inherited problem in the liver's process for removing ammonia. Ammonia can build up in the blood and cause vomiting, poor feeding, sleepiness, confusion, seizures, or brain injury, especially during illness or fasting.

Urea Nitrogen Urine Test

A urine test measuring urea nitrogen excretion, interpreted with blood urea nitrogen, creatinine, diet, and urine volume to assess protein metabolism and renal handling.

Ureaplasma

A genus of very small bacteria without a cell wall that can colonize the genital or urinary tract and is sometimes associated with urethritis or pregnancy complications.

Ureaplasma urealyticum

A bacterium without a cell wall that can live in the genital or urinary tract. It is sometimes associated with urethritis, pregnancy complications, or infection in vulnerable newborns.

Uremia

A clinical syndrome caused by advanced kidney failure and accumulation of waste products and other biologically active substances. Symptoms may include nausea, itching, fatigue, confusion, bleeding, or pericarditis; laboratory values and symptoms must be interpreted together.

Uremic Bleeding

A tendency to bleed in advanced kidney failure, mainly because platelets do not function normally. It may cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, or prolonged

bleeding.

Uremic Encephalopathy

Brain dysfunction caused by severe kidney failure and the resulting buildup of waste products. It may cause confusion, extreme sleepiness, muscle twitching, seizures, or coma.

Uremic Fetor

A urine-like or ammonia-like odor on the breath in severe kidney failure, caused when oral bacteria break down urea in saliva.

Alternate Names:
Ammoniacal Breath; Uremic Breath Odor

Uremic Frost

Rare white, powdery crystals of urea that appear on the skin when severe untreated kidney failure causes very high waste levels in the blood. It indicates advanced kidney failure.

Uremic Pericarditis

Inflammation of the sac around the heart caused by severe kidney failure and buildup of waste products. It may cause sharp chest pain, a scratchy heart sound, or fluid around the heart; fluid can sometimes compress the heart and impair its pumping.

Uremic Platelet Dysfunction

Reduced ability of platelets to stick together and stop bleeding because of advanced kidney failure. It can cause easy bruising, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or bleeding from the stomach or bowel and may improve when the kidney failure is treated.

Uremic Pruritus

Persistent itching associated with chronic kidney disease (CKD), especially advanced disease. It is now commonly called CKD-associated pruritus (CKD-aP), since itching does not directly track with uremia. The cause is complex and may involve changes in the skin, nerves, immune system, and signaling pathways.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Kidney Disease-Associated Pruritus; CKD-Associated Pruritus; CKD-aP

Uremic Stomatitis

Inflammation of the mouth caused by severe kidney failure and buildup of waste products. It may cause a bad taste, mouth soreness, white patches, ulcers, or bleeding gums and tongue.

Ureter

One of two muscular tubes that carry urine from a kidney to the bladder. A stone or narrowing can block a ureter and cause severe side pain, swelling of the kidney, infection, or kidney damage.

Ureteral Calculi

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Stones*.

Ureteral Catheters

Thin tubes passed into a ureter to drain urine, inject contrast, measure pressure, or guide a procedure. Possible complications include infection, bleeding, a tear, movement of the tube, or blockage.

Ureteral Injury During Gynecologic Surgery

Damage to a ureter during pelvic surgery, including cutting, tying off, heat injury, loss of blood supply, or blockage. It may cause flank pain, urine leakage, kidney swelling, fever, or delayed kidney injury.

Ureteral Obstruction

Blockage of urine flow through a ureter, the tube from a kidney to the bladder. Stones, scar tissue, tumors, or pressure from nearby structures can cause it and may lead to kidney swelling, infection, or reduced kidney function.

Ureteral Orifice

One of the two openings where the ureters enter the bladder and release urine. The angled passage through the bladder wall helps reduce backward flow of urine toward the kidneys.

Ureteral Perforation

A tear or hole in the ureter, sometimes caused by a stone, trauma, surgery, or an endoscopic procedure. Urine may leak into surrounding tissues and cause pain, infection, or inflammation.

Ureteral Polyp

Usually a benign fibroepithelial growth arising from the ureter. It may cause hematuria, flank pain, or obstruction and must be distinguished from urothelial malignancy when evaluated.

Ureteral Reimplantation

Surgery that moves the lower end of a ureter to a new opening in the bladder. It may be used to correct urine flowing backward, blockage, injury, or an abnormal ureter entry.

Alternate Names:
Ureteroneocystostomy; Ureteral Neoimplantation

Ureteral Retrograde Brush Biopsy

A small brush passed through a thin camera into the ureter to collect cells from its lining. A laboratory examines the cells for cancer or other abnormal changes.

Ureteral Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Stricture*.

Ureteral Stent

A thin tube placed inside the ureter to keep urine flowing from the kidney to the bladder when a stone, narrowing, tumor, or swelling blocks the passage. It can cause urinary urgency, discomfort, blood in the urine, infection, or mineral buildup and is usually temporary.

Ureteral Stones

Stones in a ureter, the tube carrying urine from a kidney to the bladder. They may cause wave-like side or groin pain, blood in the urine, nausea, blockage, or infection.

Ureteral Stricture

A scar-related narrowing of the ureter that can slow urine drainage and cause kidney swelling, side pain, infection, or reduced kidney function.

Ureter Duplex

A birth variation in which one kidney has two urine tubes instead of one. It may cause no problems but can lead to urine flowing backward, blockage, repeated infections, or poor drainage.

Ureter Fissus

A birth difference in which a ureter is divided lengthwise or partly duplicated. It may cause no symptoms, but abnormal urine flow can lead to urine reflux, blockage, repeated infection, or poor kidney drainage.

Ureteric Bud

An embryonic outgrowth of the mesonephric duct that branches within the metanephric mesenchyme. It forms the ureter, renal pelvis, calyces, and collecting ducts, which make up the kidney's collecting system. The surrounding metanephric mesenchyme forms the nephrons.

Alternate Names:
Metanephric Diverticulum

Ureteric Calculi

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Stones*.

Ureteric Colic

Severe, cramping pain caused by a stone moving through or blocking a ureter, the tube that carries urine from a kidney to the bladder. Pain often starts in the side or back and moves toward the lower abdomen or groin; blood in the urine, nausea, or vomiting may occur.

Alternate Names:
Ureteral Colic; Ureteral Calculus Pain

Ureteric Perforation

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Perforation*.

Ureteritis

Inflammation of the ureter, usually related to infection, obstruction, stone passage, instrumentation, or

adjacent inflammatory disease. It may cause flank or abdominal pain, urinary symptoms, hematuria, and fever.

Ureter Obstruction

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Obstruction*.

Ureterocele

A balloon-like dilation of the lower ureter where it enters the bladder, usually congenital; it can obstruct urine flow and cause infection, hydronephrosis, reflux, stones, or impaired renal function.

Ureterolithiasis

Alternate name; see *Ureteral Stones*.

Ureteropelvic Junction Obstruction

A blockage where the kidney's urine-collecting area joins the ureter. It may be present from birth or develop later and can cause kidney swelling, side pain, infections, stones, or loss of kidney function.

Ureteroscope

A thin camera instrument passed through the urinary passage to examine the ureter and kidney. It can help remove stones, take tissue samples, or place a stent.

Ureteroscopes

Alternate name; see *Ureteroscope*.

Ureteroscopy

Ureteroscopy uses a small endoscope passed through the urinary tract to inspect, biopsy, or treat ureteral or kidney stones and other lesions.

Ureterostomy Procedure

Surgery that creates an opening from a ureter to the skin or another urinary conduit to divert urine when normal drainage to the bladder is impossible or must be bypassed.

Urethra

The tube that carries urine from the bladder out of the body. In people with male reproductive anatomy it also carries semen; the shorter urethra in people with female reproductive anatomy makes bladder infections more likely.

Urethra Disorder

A condition affecting the urethra, such as infection, inflammation, stricture, trauma, congenital abnormality, or tumor, that may cause pain, discharge, weak stream, or retention.

Urethral Cancer

Alternate name; see *Urethral Carcinoma*.

Urethral Carcinoma

A rare cancer arising from the urethra. It may cause bleeding, a lump, discharge, pain, or difficulty urinating.

Urethral Caruncle

A small, usually benign red growth at the opening of the urethra, most often seen after menopause. It may cause bleeding, tenderness, or pain during urination.

Alternate Names:
Benign Meatal Vascular Polyp

Urethral Catheter

A tube inserted through the urethra into the bladder to drain urine, obtain a specimen, instill medication, or monitor output. Urinary infection and urethral trauma are important risks.

Urethral Catheterization

The passage of a flexible catheter through the urethra into the urinary bladder; see *Urinary Catheterization*.

Urethral Discharge

Fluid or pus coming from the urethral opening. It may result from urethritis, including a sexually transmitted infection, but can also follow irritation or injury.

Urethral Diverticulum

A pocket beside the urethra that connects with

the urine tube, often developing after infection or blockage of nearby glands. It may cause burning urination, urine dribbling after voiding, repeated infections, pain during sex, or a vaginal-wall lump.

Urethral Fistula

An abnormal channel between the urethra and another epithelial surface, often the vagina or skin. It can cause continuous urine leakage, recurrent infection, and local irritation.

Urethral Hypermobility

Excessive movement of the urethra when abdominal pressure rises, contributing to urine leakage during coughing, lifting, or exercise.

Urethral Infection

Infection involving the urethra, commonly caused by bacteria, including sexually transmitted organisms. Symptoms may include burning urination, discharge, frequent urination, or pelvic discomfort.

Urethral Injury

Alternate name; see *Urethral Trauma*.

Urethral Meatus

The external opening of the urethra through which urine leaves the body. Its position may be abnormal in conditions such as hypospadias or epispadias.

Urethral Obstruction

Partial or complete blockage of urine leaving the bladder, often from stricture, stone, prostate disease, tumor, or a congenital valve. Acute retention can damage the bladder or kidneys.

Urethral Pressure Profile

A test using a small catheter to measure pressure along the urethra and assess how well it closes. It may help investigate certain types of urine leakage or difficulty emptying the bladder.

Urethral Prolapse

Protrusion of the inner lining of the urethra through its opening. It may appear as a red ring of tissue and can cause bleeding, pain, or difficulty urinating; it occurs most often in young children and after menopause.

Alternate Names:
Urethral Mucosal Prolapse; Meatal Eversion

Urethral Sling

A strip of synthetic material or the person's own tissue placed beneath the urethra to support it and reduce urine leakage during coughing, lifting, or exercise. Possible complications include urgency, difficulty urinating, infection, or erosion.

Urethral Sphincter

Muscles around the urine tube that help keep urine from leaking and relax when a person urinates. Nerve or muscle damage can weaken control and cause leakage or difficulty emptying the bladder.

Urethral Stenosis

Alternate name; see *Urethral Stricture*.

Urethral Stent

A small tube placed inside the urethra to help keep a narrowed or blocked segment open and allow urine to pass. Migration, blockage, infection, pain, or tissue injury can occur.

Urethral Stricture

A narrowing of the urethra, the tube that carries urine out of the body, usually caused by scar tissue. The narrowing can slow or block urine flow and may cause a weak or spraying stream, straining, pain with urination, dribbling, or incomplete bladder emptying. It can lead to repeated urinary infections, urinary retention, and, if severe or prolonged, damage to the bladder or kidneys. Causes include injury, infection, surgery, radiation, or previous use of a catheter or other instrument; sometimes no cause is found.

Urethral Syndrome

An older term for urethral pain syndrome, a pattern of recurrent pain felt in the urethra, usually during urination and sometimes with daytime frequency or nighttime urination, when no infection or other

obvious local cause is found. The term is no longer recommended because it does not identify a specific cause.

Urethral Trauma

Injury to the urethra caused by a pelvic fracture, blunt or penetrating trauma, or medical instrumentation. It may cause bleeding at the urethral opening, difficulty passing urine, bruising, or leakage of urine into nearby tissues.

Urethritis

Inflammation of the urethra, often caused by infection, including sexually transmitted infections, but sometimes by irritation or injury. It can cause burning urination, itching, pelvic discomfort, or discharge.

Urethrocele

Prolapse of the urethra into the front wall of the vagina. It may cause a vaginal bulge, pelvic pressure, urine leakage, or difficulty emptying the bladder, but can also cause no symptoms.

Urethrography

An X-ray test in which contrast liquid outlines the urethra, the tube carrying urine out of the body. It can show narrowing, leaks, injury, abnormal connections, or birth differences.

Urethroplasty

Surgery that rebuilds or widens the urine tube, most often to treat a narrowing called a stricture. It may use nearby tissue or a graft and aims to improve urine flow.

Urethroscopy

Examination of the urethra with a thin camera passed through its opening. It can identify narrowing, injury, inflammation, stones, tumors, or other abnormalities and may allow treatment during the same procedure.

Urge Incontinence

Leakage of urine that happens with or just after a sudden, hard-to-delay need to urinate. It may occur with overactive bladder, infection, bladder irritation, nerve disease, or other conditions.

Alternate Names:
Urgency Urinary Incontinence

Urgency

A sudden, difficult-to-delay need to urinate. It may result from a urinary infection, bladder irritation, overactive bladder, a stone, nerve disease, prostate enlargement, or pelvic-floor problems.

Urge Urinary Incontinence

Alternate name; see *Urge Incontinence*.

Uric Acid

A waste product formed when the body breaks down purines. High blood levels can cause gout or kidney stones, although many people with high levels have no symptoms.

Uric Acid Nephrolithiasis

Formation or presence of kidney stones made mainly of uric acid. They form more readily when urine is persistently acidic and may not show on a plain X-ray, though they can be seen on CT.

Alternate Names:
Uric Acid Calculi

Uric Acid Nephropathy

Kidney injury caused when too much uric acid forms crystals in the kidney's small tubes. It can occur during rapid breakdown of cancer cells or severe uric-acid excess.

Uric Acid Stones

Stones composed mainly of uric acid that form in the kidney or elsewhere in the urinary tract. They form more readily in persistently acidic urine and may be associated with gout, high uric acid levels, or chronic diarrhea.

Uric Acid Urine Test

A urine test measuring uric acid excretion, used in evaluation of gout, kidney stones, uric-acid overpro-

duction, and selected metabolic disorders.

Uricosuria

Excretion of uric acid in urine. The amount depends on uric-acid production, diet, kidney handling, and medicines. Excess urinary uric acid, called hyperuricosuria, can contribute to uric acid or calcium oxalate stones and may be assessed with a timed urine collection.

Uricosuric Drug

A medicine that increases renal excretion of uric acid, such as probenecid, used in selected patients with gout.

Uridine Triacetate

An oral prodrug that supplies uridine and is used as an emergency antidote for severe or life-threatening toxicity from fluorouracil or related fluoropyrimidines, under specialist direction.

Urinal

A portable container used to collect urine from someone who cannot easily reach a toilet. It is used in bed or beside a chair and can be designed for different body types.

Urinalysis

Laboratory examination of urine for its appearance, acidity, blood, cells, protein, sugar, ketones, bacteria, and other substances. It can provide clues to infection, kidney disease, bleeding, diabetes, dehydration, and other illness.

Urinary

Relating to urine or to the organs and processes involved in making, storing, and passing urine, including the kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra.

Urinary Anion Gap

A calculated value—urine sodium plus potassium minus chloride—used as an indirect estimate of urinary ammonium excretion. It can help assess the renal response to metabolic acidosis, but does not directly measure ammonium or identify the cause of the acidosis.

Alternate Names:
UAG

Urinary Bladder

A hollow muscular organ in the lower abdomen that stores urine until it is released through the urethra.

Urinary Bladder Disorder

A disease affecting bladder storage or emptying, including infection, overactivity, pain syndrome, stones, tumor, neurologic dysfunction, or outlet obstruction.

Urinary Bladder Squamous Cell Carcinoma Pathology

An invasive malignant squamous neoplasm of the bladder showing keratinization, intercellular bridges, or both. It may be associated with chronic irritation, infection, stones, or schistosomiasis and is assessed for depth of invasion.

Urinary Calculi

Hard deposits formed when substances in urine crystallize and aggregate in the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra. Composition varies and may include calcium salts, uric acid, struvite, or cystine. Some pass without symptoms; others can cause renal colic, blood in urine, obstruction, infection, or kidney injury, depending on their size and location.

Urinary Casts

Small tube-shaped particles formed inside kidney tubules and passed in urine. Their appearance can provide clues about kidney inflammation, bleeding, infection, or damage.

Urinary Catheter

A sterile, flexible hollow tube constructed of latex, silicone, or polyurethane inserted percutaneously or through the urethra into the urinary bladder to facilitate urinary drainage, bladder decompression, urinary output monitoring, or instillation of therapeutic agents. Types include indwelling Foley catheters (retained via an inflated balloon), intermit-

tent straight catheters, external condom catheters, and suprapubic catheters. Prolonged indwelling catheterization represents the principal risk factor for catheter-associated urinary tract infections (CAUTI), bladder spasms, and urethral strictures.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Catheters; Foley Catheter; Indwelling Catheter

Urinary Catheterization

Insertion of a tube into the bladder to drain urine, measure output, obtain a specimen, or deliver treatment; infection, trauma, and blockage are possible complications.

Urinary Catheters

Plural form; see *Urinary Catheter*.

Urinary Diversion

Surgical or catheter-based rerouting of urine when the normal passage from the kidneys to the urethra cannot be used, often to a stoma or bowel reservoir.

Urinary Fistula

An abnormal connection between part of the urinary tract and another organ or the skin, allowing urine to leak outside its normal pathway. Causes include surgery, childbirth injury, inflammation, and cancer.

Urinary Frequency

The need to urinate more often than usual, which may result from infection, bladder irritation, increased urine production, or other urinary disorders.

Urinary Hesitancy

Alternate name; see *Urinary Hesitation*.

Urinary Hesitation

A delay or difficulty starting urination after a person is ready to void. Causes include prostate enlargement, urethral narrowing, medicines, pain, nerve disorders, or weak bladder contraction. Hesitancy is a symptom rather than a diagnosis; accompanying stream changes or incomplete emptying help characterize it.

Urinary Incontinence

Unwanted leakage of urine. It may happen with coughing or exercise, a sudden strong urge, an overfull bladder, difficulty reaching the toilet, or nerve and muscle problems. More than one pattern may occur in the same person.

Alternate Names:
Loss of Bladder Control

Urinary Lithiasis

Alternate name; see *Urolithiasis*.

Urinary Retention

Inability to empty the bladder fully. It may be sudden and painful or develop gradually with a weak stream, frequent small amounts of urine, or leakage from an overfull bladder. Blockage, medicines, nerve problems, or weak bladder muscles can cause it.

Urinary Retraining

Scheduled toilet visits and bladder-control techniques used to reduce urgency, frequent urination, or leakage. It may include gradually extending the time between urination and practicing ways to delay an urge.

Urinary Stasis

Slowing or stopping of normal urine flow, which can promote urinary infection, stone formation, or obstruction-related kidney injury.

Urinary System

The kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra. Together they filter blood, make and transport urine, store and remove it, and help regulate fluid volume, electrolytes, acid-base balance, blood pressure, and hormone-related functions such as red-cell production.

Urinary Tract

The kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra. Together these organs make urine, carry it to the bladder, store it, and remove it from the body.

Urinary Tract Disorder

Any disease of the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra, including infection, stones, obstruction, congenital abnormalities, cancer, and functional or neurologic disorders.

Urinary Tract Imaging

Imaging tests used to examine the kidneys, ureters, bladder, and urethra. Methods include ultrasound, X-ray studies, computed tomography, magnetic resonance imaging, and nuclear scans, chosen according to the suspected problem.

Urinary Tract Infection

An infection affecting any part of the urinary system, most commonly involving the bladder (cystitis) or the kidneys (pyelonephritis). It usually occurs when bacteria from the digestive tract enter the urethra and travel upward into the urinary tract. A bladder infection classically causes a burning sensation during urination, frequent and urgent needs to urinate, cloudy or strong-smelling urine, and lower abdominal discomfort, while an infection that spreads to the kidneys can cause fever, chills, nausea, and severe back or side pain.

Alternate Names:
UTI; Cystitis; Pyelonephritis; Bladder Infection

Urinary Tract Infection In Adults

A urinary infection in an adult involving the bladder, urethra, kidneys, or another part of the urinary tract. Symptoms vary by site and may include painful urination, frequency, urgency, blood in the urine, fever, or flank pain.

Urinary Tract Infection In Children

A urinary infection in a child involving the bladder, kidneys, ureters, or urethra. Symptoms may include fever, painful or frequent urination, new wetting, abdominal or back pain, vomiting, or unusual irritability.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric UTI

Urinary Tract Infection In Pregnancy

A term covering asymptomatic bacteriuria and symptomatic infection of the urinary tract during pregnancy, including bladder or kidney infection. Kidney infection can cause serious maternal and fetal complications.

Urinary Tract Infections in Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Urinary Tract Infection In Pregnancy*.

Urinary Tract Infection (UTI)

Alternate name; see *Urinary Tract Infection*.

Urinary Tract Neoplasm

A benign or malignant growth in the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra; evaluation depends on its site, symptoms, tissue type, and extent of spread.

Urinary Tract Obstruction

A blockage that slows or stops urine flow anywhere from the kidneys to the urethral opening. It can cause urine to back up, kidney injury, or infection.

Urinary Tract Trauma

Injury to one or more parts of the urinary tract—the kidneys, ureters, bladder, or urethra—caused by a blow, crash, fall, or penetrating wound. It may cause blood in the urine, pain, difficulty urinating, urine leakage, or internal bleeding. The effects depend on which part is injured and how badly.

Urinary Urgency

A sudden, difficult-to-delay need to urinate. It may occur with urinary infection, bladder irritation, overactive bladder, stones, neurologic disease, or other conditions.

Urination

The process of releasing urine from the bladder through the urethra and out of the body.

Alternate Names:
Micturition; Voiding

Urination Disorder

Abnormal storage or emptying of urine causing fre-

quency, urgency, dysuria, incontinence, hesitancy, weak stream, retention, or excessive or reduced urine output.

Urine

The liquid waste produced by the kidneys, containing water and dissolved substances eliminated from the blood.

Urine 24-Hour Volume

Twenty-four-hour urine volume is the total urine produced in a day and helps assess hydration, kidney function, endocrine disease, or abnormal urine production.

Urine Albumin-to-Creatinine Ratio

A urine test comparing albumin to creatinine concentration in a single sample to detect early kidney damage and microalbuminuria; see *Albumin-To-Creatinine Ratio*.

Urine Albuminuria

Alternate name; see *Albuminuria*.

Urine Alkalinization

Treatment that makes urine less acidic, usually with a carefully monitored medicine, to help remove certain poisons such as salicylate. It can disturb body salts or fluid balance and is used only for selected cases.

Urine Amylase Test

A urine test that measures the amount of amylase passed from the body. It may help assess pancreatitis, salivary-gland problems, or unusually high amylase levels in the blood.

Alternate Names:
Urine Amylase; Urinary Amylase Test; Amylase Urine Test

Urine Analysis

Alternate name; see *Urinalysis*.

Urine Bilirubin Test

A urine test that detects conjugated (water-soluble) bilirubin. A positive result can occur with liver or bile-duct disease; unconjugated bilirubin does not normally pass into urine.

Alternate Names:
Urine Bilirubin; Urinary Bilirubin Test

Urine Calcium Test

A diagnostic urinalysis quantifying urinary calcium excretion, typically measured in a 24-hour urine collection. It is utilized in the evaluation and metabolic workup of nephrolithiasis, hyperparathyroidism, osteomalacia, and idiopathic hypercalciuria.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Calcium; 24-Hour Urine Calcium; Urine Calcium Excretion

Urine Catecholamine Test

A urine test that measures catecholamines or their breakdown products. It may help assess certain hormone-producing tumors, such as pheochromocytoma or paraganglioma; tests of metanephrines are commonly preferred for these tumors.

Alternate Names:
24-Hour Urine Catecholamines; Urinary Catecholamines; Fractionated Urinary Catecholamines

Urine Chemistry

Measurement of chemical constituents in urine, such as glucose, protein, electrolytes, ketones, blood, and pH, to evaluate kidney function and systemic disease.

Urine Chloride Test

A test that measures chloride in urine. The result can help evaluate fluid and electrolyte disorders, including some causes of metabolic alkalosis, but must be interpreted with the clinical context and other laboratory results.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Chloride; Urine Chloride Excretion; Spot Urine Chloride

Urine Concentration Test

A test of the kidney's ability to concentrate urine, assessed by urine osmolality or specific gravity after

controlled fluid conditions when appropriate.

Urine Conductivity

Urine conductivity measures how readily urine carries electrical current and reflects its dissolved electrolyte and solute concentration.

Urine Culture

A laboratory test that grows microorganisms from a urine specimen to identify urinary-tract infection and guide antimicrobial selection. Results may report the organism, quantity of growth, and antimicrobial susceptibility. Contamination can produce misleading growth, and bacteria may be present without causing symptoms.

Urine Cytology

Microscopic examination of cells shed into urine, mainly used to help detect high-grade urothelial carcinoma and some other abnormalities. A negative result does not exclude all urinary-tract cancers.

Urine Dipstick

A strip placed in urine that changes color to screen for findings such as blood, protein, sugar, ketones, and signs of infection. Results are preliminary and can be affected by urine concentration, medicines, and contamination.

Urine Drainage Bag

A bag connected to a urinary catheter or diversion to collect urine.

Urine Electrolytes Test

A test measuring electrolytes, such as sodium, potassium, and chloride, in urine. Results can help assess kidney handling of electrolytes and contribute to evaluation of fluid, electrolyte, and acid-base disorders.

Alternate Names:
Urinary Electrolytes; Spot Urine Electrolytes; 24-Hour Urine Electrolytes

Urine Formation

The process by which the kidneys make urine: they filter blood, return needed water and substances to the body, and add selected wastes and extra ions to the fluid that leaves as urine.

Urine HCG Test

A urine test that detects human chorionic gonadotropin (hCG), a hormone usually produced during pregnancy. Testing too early or using diluted urine can give a false-negative result; a positive result usually indicates pregnancy but does not show its location or viability.

Alternate Names:
Urine hCG Test

Urine Hemoglobin

Free hemoglobin in urine, usually from breakdown of red blood cells within the circulation. A urine dipstick detects heme and can also be positive from intact red blood cells or myoglobin, so microscopy and other findings help distinguish these causes.

Urine Immunoelectrophoresis

A laboratory test that separates urine proteins and uses antibodies to identify specific proteins, including monoclonal immunoglobulins or light chains.

Alternate Names:
Urine IEP; Urinary Protein Immunoelectrophoresis

Urine Immunofixation

A laboratory test that uses electrophoresis and antibodies to identify specific proteins in urine, especially monoclonal immunoglobulins or light chains.

Alternate Names:
Urine IFE; Urinary Immunofixation Electrophoresis; Bence Jones Protein IFE

Urine Osmolality

A measure of how concentrated urine is. It reflects the kidneys' ability to conserve or remove water and varies with fluid intake, medicines, kidney function, and blood chemistry.

Urine pH

A measurement of urine acidity or alkalinity. It varies with diet, metabolism, medicines, infection,

and kidney function and can influence the formation of some urinary stones.

Urine PH Test

Alternate name; see *Urine pH*.

Urine Protein Dipstick Test

A screening test using a reagent strip to detect mainly albumin in urine; positive results may reflect persistent protein loss or temporary changes such as fever or exercise.

Urine Protein Electrophoresis Test

A laboratory test that separates urine proteins by electrical charge and size to help detect abnormal proteins, including monoclonal light chains associated with plasma-cell disorders.

Urine Protein Test

A urine test that detects or quantifies protein in the urine, an early indicator of kidney disease; see *Urine Protein Dipstick Test*.

Urine Retention

Alternate name; see *Urinary Retention*.

Urine Sediment

The cells, crystals, casts, and other particles seen under a microscope after urine is concentrated. Their appearance can provide clues to bleeding, infection, stones, or kidney inflammation.

Urine Sodium

The amount of sodium in urine. It can help assess fluid balance and kidney handling of salt, but results are strongly affected by diet, medicines, hydration, and the timing of the sample.

Urine Specific Gravity Test

A test comparing the density of urine with the density of water. It gives a rough estimate of how concentrated the urine is and can help assess hydration and the kidneys' ability to conserve water.

Urine Toxicology

Laboratory analysis of urine for medicines, drugs, or their metabolites. Results require interpretation because detection does not always establish impairment or the timing of exposure.

Urinoma

A collection of urine that has leaked into tissues around the kidney or urinary tract, usually because of an injury, blockage, or medical procedure. It may cause pain, swelling, infection, or pressure on nearby structures; treatment may involve drainage or repair.

Alternate Names:
Urine Pseudocyst

Urinometer

An instrument that measures how dense urine is compared with water. The result gives an estimate of urine concentration and may help assess hydration or the kidney's ability to conserve water.

URI (Upper Respiratory Infection)

Abbreviation; see *Upper Respiratory Tract Infection*.

Urobilinogen

A colourless product formed in the intestine from bilirubin and partly reabsorbed and excreted in urine; abnormal levels may provide clues to liver disease or haemolysis.

Urodynamics

A group of tests that measures how the bladder stores urine, how pressure changes as it fills, and how the urethra and bladder release urine. It helps investigate leakage, urgency, weak stream, or difficulty emptying when simpler tests are inconclusive.

Urodynamic Testing

Alternate name; see *Urodynamics*.

Uroflow

A test that measures how quickly and steadily urine leaves the body during urination. The result can

suggest blockage, weak bladder muscles, or other emptying problems, but it is interpreted with symptoms and sometimes additional tests.

Uroflowmetry

A noninvasive test that measures the rate and pattern of urine flow during urination. Results can suggest blockage or weak bladder contraction but are interpreted with symptoms and other findings.

Urogenital

Relating to the urinary and reproductive systems or structures involving both. The term may describe organs, infections, cancers, birth conditions, injuries, symptoms, tests, or treatments affecting these closely connected body systems.

Urogenital Fistula

An abnormal connection between the urinary and genital tracts, such as a vesicovaginal or ureterovaginal fistula. It commonly causes continuous urinary leakage and may result from childbirth injury, surgery, radiation, or cancer.

Urogenital Sinus

A birth-related abnormality in which the urethra and vagina join into a common channel before reaching the outside of the body. It may occur with differences in the external genitalia, urinary tract, or reproductive organs.

Urogenital System

The related urinary and reproductive organs and their associated ducts, vessels, and supporting tissues. The systems share developmental origins and anatomic relationships.

Urogenital Tract

The combined urinary and reproductive organs and passages. These include kidneys, urine tubes, bladder, urethra, reproductive organs, and connected structures that develop partly from related tissues before birth.

Urography

Imaging of the urinary tract, traditionally using X-rays after contrast dye is given. It can show the kidneys, urine tubes, bladder, narrowing, stones, leaks, blockage, or other structural problems.

Urokinase

A plasminogen activator produced by the body and also used as a thrombolytic medicine to help dissolve blood clots.

Urolithiasis

The formation or presence of hard mineral deposits (calculi or stones) anywhere within the urinary system, including the kidneys, ureters, or bladder. Stones develop when urine contains high levels of dissolved minerals—such as calcium, oxalate, or uric acid—and too little liquid, allowing crystals to stick together and grow. While small stones may pass out of the body unnoticed in urine, larger stones moving into the narrow ureter can cause sudden, excruciating flank pain that radiates to the lower abdomen and groin, along with blood in the urine, nausea, and painful urination.

Alternate Names:
Nephrolithiasis; Kidney Stones; Renal Calculi; Urinary Calculi

Urologic Diagnostic Yield

The proportion of tests or procedures in urology that produce a diagnostic result.

Urologist

A doctor who specializes in the urinary system and, in many practices, the male reproductive system. Urologists diagnose and treat kidney stones, infections, urine leakage, prostate problems, cancers, infertility, and conditions requiring procedures or surgery.

Urology

The medical and surgical specialty concerned with the urinary tract in all sexes and the male reproductive system. It includes diseases of the kidneys, ureters, bladder, urethra, prostate, and testes, as well as urinary stones, cancers, and disorders of

urination.

Uropathy

Disease or damage affecting the kidneys or urinary tract. Blockage, infection, stones, urine flowing backward, medicines, and other conditions can cause it and may reduce kidney function.

Urosepsis

Sepsis caused by infection in the urinary tract, often involving the kidneys. It is life-threatening organ dysfunction caused by a dysregulated response to infection and may progress to septic shock.

Urostomy

A surgically created opening that diverts urine from the urinary tract through the abdominal wall into an external pouch or appliance. It may be formed with a segment of intestine after bladder removal or when normal urinary drainage is not possible.

Urostomy Leak

Escape of urine beneath or around a urostomy appliance or from a surgical connection. Persistent leakage can irritate the skin and may signal poor appliance fit, obstruction, infection, or a surgical complication.

Urostomy Procedure

Surgery that diverts urine through a stoma into an external pouch or conduit, commonly after bladder removal or when the lower urinary tract cannot safely transport urine.

Urostomy Prolapse

Protrusion of a segment of bowel used as a urostomy stoma beyond its usual level. It may cause bleeding, swelling, appliance problems, or impaired urine drainage; severe prolapse can impair blood flow to the bowel segment.

Urostomy Stenosis

Narrowing of a urinary stoma or conduit that impedes drainage, causing reduced urine output, leakage, infection, or kidney-pressure changes and sometimes requiring revision.

Urothelial Carcinoma

A cancer arising from the stretchable lining of the urinary tract, most often the bladder but also the kidney's drainage area, ureters, or urethra. Blood in the urine is common, and treatment depends on location, depth, grade, and spread.

Urothelium

A specialized stretchable lining of the renal pelvis, ureters, bladder, and part of the urethra. It forms a protective barrier between urine and underlying tissues and allows the bladder to expand.

Urotrauma

Injury to the urinary or genital organs, including the kidneys, ureters, bladder, urethra, or external genitalia. It may result from blunt force, penetrating wounds, fractures, surgery, or medical instruments.

Ursodeoxycholic Acid

A hydrophilic bile acid used for primary biliary cholangitis and selected cholestatic liver diseases; it may also dissolve certain small cholesterol gallstones when bile flow is preserved.

Urticaria

Commonly known as hives, a common skin reaction characterized by the sudden appearance of itchy, raised, red or skin-colored welts (wheals). It occurs when specialized immune cells in the skin (mast cells) release histamine and other inflammatory chemicals, causing tiny blood vessels to widen and leak fluid into the surrounding tissue. Hives can be triggered by allergic reactions to foods, medications, insect stings, viral infections, physical pressure, or stress, and individual welts typically appear, shift, and fade within 24 hours without leaving scars.

Alternate Names:
Hives; Nettle Rash; Wheals

Urticaria And Angioedema

The simultaneous occurrence of urticaria, with transient itchy wheals, and angioedema, with deeper swelling of the skin or mucosa. The combination

commonly reflects histamine-mediated inflammation, although the two findings can also occur separately.

Urticarial Vasculitis

Inflammation of small blood vessels in the skin that causes hive-like patches, with individual lesions usually lasting more than 24 hours. Unlike common hives, the patches may burn or hurt and can leave bruise-like discoloration or dark marks as they fade. The disease may affect only the skin; some people, especially those with low blood levels of complement proteins, also develop joint, kidney, lung, or other organ problems.

Urticaria Multiforme

A short-lived form of acute urticaria in children, also called acute annular urticaria. It causes annular or polycyclic itchy wheals, often with swelling of the hands, feet, or face. Individual wheals are transient, unlike the fixed target lesions of erythema multiforme.

Urticaria Pigmentosa

An older name for maculopapular cutaneous mastocytosis, a condition in which mast cells collect in the skin and form tan or brown spots or bumps that may swell and itch when rubbed. Some people also have symptoms from mast-cell chemicals released elsewhere in the body.

Usher Syndrome

An inherited condition causing hearing loss together with gradually worsening vision from retinal disease. The age and severity vary by type; some forms also affect balance.

Ustekinumab

A biologic medicine that blocks immune signals involved in inflammation. It is used for psoriasis, psoriatic arthritis, Crohn disease, ulcerative colitis, and other approved conditions; infections and allergic reactions are important risks.

Usual Ductal Hyperplasia

A benign increase in the number of cells lining the breast ducts. The cells look close to normal, unlike the abnormal cells in atypical ductal hyperplasia; it is associated with a slight increase in breast cancer risk.

Usual Interstitial Pneumonia

A pattern of permanent scarring in the lungs, often seen in idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis. Scarring is usually greatest near the outer and lower parts of the lungs and can form small spaces called honeycombing. It causes increasing breathlessness and cough and is assessed with lung tests and CT imaging.

Usual Interstitial Pneumonia Pathology

A patchy, temporally heterogeneous interstitial fibrosing pattern with subpleural or paraseptal fibrosis, fibroblastic foci, architectural distortion, and honeycomb change. It is a characteristic pattern of idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis but can occur in other conditions.

Ut Dict.

An abbreviation of the Latin phrase “ut dictum,” meaning “as stated” or “as directed.” In medical notes it refers the reader to information already given or to an instruction previously specified.

Uterine Adnexae

The structures beside and connected to the uterus, mainly the fallopian tubes, ovaries, and supporting tissues. Problems in these structures can cause pelvic pain, abnormal bleeding, infertility, or an ectopic pregnancy.

Uterine Adhesions

Alternate name; see *Intrauterine Adhesions*.

Uterine Arteriovenous Malformation

A rare abnormal set of blood vessels in the uterus, with direct connections between arteries and veins. It may be present from birth; similar abnormal connections that develop after pregnancy or uterine procedures are also sometimes called acquired malformations, though terminology varies. These lesions can cause severe vaginal bleeding.

Uterine Artery Aneurysm

A rare bulge or abnormal widening in the wall of an artery that supplies the uterus. A true aneurysm involves the artery wall, while a pseudoaneurysm is a leak contained by nearby tissue, often after childbirth or a procedure. Rupture can cause severe internal or vaginal bleeding.

Uterine Artery Embolization

A minimally invasive procedure in which particles or another material are delivered through a catheter to block selected blood flow in the uterine arteries. It is used mainly to shrink fibroids and can also control severe bleeding after childbirth; possible effects include pain, infection, and changes in fertility or pregnancy outcomes.

Uterine Atony

Failure of the uterus to contract effectively after childbirth, which can cause heavy postpartum bleeding. It is the most common cause of postpartum hemorrhage.

Alternate Names:
Postpartum Uterine Atony

Uterine Atrophy

A reduction in the overall size or thickness of the uterus, which may involve its lining, muscular wall, or both. It can occur when estrogen levels fall, including after menopause, or after some treatments. Endometrial atrophy refers specifically to thinning of the uterine lining.

Uterine Balloon Tamponade

A treatment for severe bleeding after childbirth when medicines do not control bleeding. A soft balloon is placed inside the uterus and filled with sterile fluid to press against the uterine wall and slow or stop blood loss while other treatment is arranged.

Uterine Bleeding

Bleeding from the uterus outside the expected menstrual pattern or in an abnormal amount. Causes include pregnancy complications, fibroids, polyps, hormonal changes, medicines, infection, and cancer; heavy or postmenopausal bleeding can have an underlying medical cause.

Uterine Cancer

Cancer arising in the uterus, most commonly from the endometrium. It may cause abnormal vaginal bleeding, bleeding after menopause, pelvic pain, or unusual discharge.

Uterine Carcinosarcoma

An uncommon, aggressive cancer of the uterus with cells that look like both gland-lining cancer cells and connective-tissue cancer cells. It may cause vaginal bleeding, pelvic pain, or an enlarging mass, but some cases cause no early symptoms. Diagnosis is made by examining a tissue sample.

Uterine Cavity

The hollow space inside the uterus, lined by the endometrium. A fertilized egg normally implants in this lining, which thickens during the menstrual cycle and supports pregnancy; polyps, fibroids, scar tissue, or abnormal shape may affect it.

Uterine Compression Suture

A stitch placed around the uterus to press its walls together and control severe bleeding after childbirth when the uterus does not contract well. The B-Lynch suture is one example; other compression-suture techniques are also used.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Bracing Suture

Uterine Contraction

Tightening of the uterine muscle. Contractions occur during menstruation and labor and may also occur at other times, including as irregular practice contractions in pregnancy. Their timing, strength, and pattern vary with the cause.

Uterine Diseases

Conditions affecting the womb, including fibroids, adenomyosis, endometriosis, infection, unusual bleeding, prolapse, and cancer. Symptoms may include pain, heavy periods, infertility, pressure, discharge, or bleeding after menopause.

Uterine Fibroid

A non-cancerous (benign) growth of smooth muscle and fibrous connective tissue that develops in the muscular wall of the uterus (womb). Very common in women during their reproductive years, fibroids vary in size from undetectable tiny seedlings to large bulky masses that can enlarge and distort the shape of the uterus. While many cause no symptoms, larger or strategically located fibroids can cause heavy or prolonged menstrual bleeding, pelvic pressure or aching, frequent urination, and difficulty conceiving.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Fibroids; Uterine Leiomyoma; Uterine Leiomyomas; Myoma; Fibromyoma

Uterine Fibroid Embolization

Alternate name; see *Uterine Artery Embolization*.

Uterine Fibroids

Plural form; see *Uterine Fibroid*.

Uterine Fibroids (Leiomyomas)

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroid*.

Uterine Fistula

A uterine fistula is an abnormal passage connecting the uterus with another organ or the skin, often after surgery, childbirth injury, infection, or cancer.

Uterine Fornix

One of the shallow spaces at the top of the vagina surrounding the cervix. A clinician can examine these spaces during a pelvic examination, and selected procedures may use them as an access route.

Uterine Gland

A small gland in the lining of the uterus that produces fluid and helps support the early embryo. Its activity changes during the menstrual cycle and pregnancy.

Uterine Growths

Abnormal masses in or on the uterus, most commonly benign fibroids or endometrial polyps and less commonly cancer. They may cause heavy or irregular bleeding, pelvic pressure, pain, or fertility problems, but some cause no symptoms. Adenomyosis is a different condition in which tissue like the uterine lining grows into the muscular wall; it is not a uterine growth.

Uterine Hemorrhage

Heavy or abnormal bleeding from the uterus, occurring during pregnancy, after childbirth, or at other times. Causes include pregnancy complications, fibroids, hormonal disorders, and malignancy; severe bleeding with dizziness or weakness is an emergency.

Uterine Hematometra

Alternate name; see *Hematometra*.

Uterine Inversion

A rare, life-threatening complication of childbirth in which the uterus turns partly or completely inside out and may protrude into or beyond the vagina. It can cause severe bleeding, shock, and intense pain. Treatment restores the uterus and controls blood loss.

Uterine Infertility Factors

Structural or functional conditions of the uterus that may reduce the chance of an embryo attaching to the uterine lining or of carrying a pregnancy. Examples include fibroids that distort the uterine space, endometrial polyps, scar bands, differences in uterine shape present from birth, and disorders of the lining. These factors do not always cause infertility.

Uterine Leiomyoma

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroid*.

Uterine Leiomyomas

Plural form; see *Uterine Fibroid*.

Uterine Leiomyosarcoma

A rare malignant tumor of uterine smooth muscle that may cause abnormal bleeding, pelvic pain, or an enlarging mass; diagnosis is based on tissue

examination and staging.

Uterine Monitoring

Recording how often and how long the uterus contracts during labor. Contraction strength may be estimated by touch or measured with a pressure sensor inside the uterus; monitoring helps assess labor patterns and the response to labor medicines.

Uterine Myomectomy

Surgical removal of uterine fibroids while preserving the uterus; it may be performed through hysteroscopy, laparoscopy, or open surgery depending on fibroid size and location.

Uterine Obstruction

Blockage that prevents normal passage through the uterus or cervix, which may cause menstrual outflow obstruction, infertility, pregnancy complications, or retained blood or tissue.

Uterine Perforation

A hole through the wall of the uterus, most often caused by an instrument used during a procedure such as hysteroscopy or removal of uterine tissue. It can cause internal bleeding or injury to nearby organs and may need repair.

Uterine Polyp

A growth from the lining of the uterus that sticks into its inner space. Most are not cancer. They may cause irregular or heavy bleeding, bleeding after menopause, or difficulty becoming pregnant, but often cause no symptoms. Some contain precancerous or cancer cells.

Alternate Names:
Uterine Polyps; Endometrial Polyp; Endometrial Polyps; Intrauterine Polyp; Intrauterine Polyps

Uterine Polyps

Alternate name; see *Uterine Polyp*.

Uterine Prolapse

Descent of the uterus toward or through the vaginal opening because pelvic-floor muscles and supporting tissues have weakened. It may cause pelvic pressure, a bulge, backache, urinary or bowel problems, or discomfort during sex; childbirth and aging increase risk.

Alternate Names:
Descensus Uteri; Uterine Herniation

Uterine Pyometra

Alternate name; see *Pyometra*.

Uterine Rupture

A full-thickness tear of the uterine wall that occurs in late pregnancy before labor or during labor. It most often involves a prior uterine surgical scar, especially after cesarean delivery or myomectomy, but can occur in an unscarred uterus. It may cause severe maternal hemorrhage and compromise fetal oxygen supply. Unlike scar dehiscence, complete rupture extends through the outer uterine layer.

Uterine Rupture in Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Uterine Rupture*.

Uterine Sarcoma

Uterine sarcoma is a rare malignant tumor arising from uterine muscle, connective tissue, or related cells and may cause bleeding, pain, or an enlarging mass.

Uterine Septum

Alternate name; see *Septate Uterus*.

Uterine Tachysystole

More than five uterine contractions in 10 minutes, averaged over a 30-minute period during labor. The pattern is assessed together with the fetal heart rate because frequent contractions can be associated with fetal heart-rate changes.

Uterine Tube

A paired muscular tube that carries an egg from the ovary toward the uterus and is the usual site of fertilization.

Alternate Names:
Fallopian Tube; Oviduct

Uterine Tumors

Abnormal growths in or on the uterus. They include noncancerous fibroids and polyps as well as rare cancers; assessment depends on symptoms, imaging, and sometimes tissue testing.

Utero-Ovarian Ligament

A band of tissue connecting each ovary to the uterus. It helps hold the ovary in position within the pelvis and lies near the fallopian tube and other pelvic supporting tissues.

Alternate Names:
Ovarian Ligament; Proper Ovarian Ligament

Uteroplacental Insufficiency

Reduced blood flow or function of the placenta that limits the supply of oxygen and nutrients to the fetus. It may contribute to poor fetal growth or signs of fetal distress; causes include maternal health conditions and problems with placental development.

Alternate Names:
Placental Insufficiency

Uterosacral Ligament

One of two strong bands of tissue supporting the uterus and top of the vagina by attaching them toward the sacrum at the back of the pelvis. Weakness can contribute to pelvic-organ prolapse; endometriosis can also affect or cause pain in this area.

Uterus

A hollow muscular organ in the pelvis between the bladder and rectum. Its inner lining thickens to prepare for pregnancy and is shed during menstruation. A fertilized egg normally implants in this lining, and a fetus develops in the uterus during pregnancy.

Common name: Womb

Uterus Didelphys

A congenital condition in which two separate uteruses develop, often with two cervixes and a dividing wall in the vagina. Many people can become pregnant, but miscarriage, premature birth, abnormal fetal position, or other pregnancy complications are more common.

Alternate Names:
Double Uterus; Didelphic Uterus

Uterus Disorder

A condition affecting the uterus, including fibroids, adenomyosis, endometriosis, infection, abnormal bleeding, congenital anomalies, prolapse, and cancer.

Uterus Neoplasm

A benign or malignant growth arising in the uterus, including fibroids, endometrial cancer, and sarcomas; diagnosis depends on examination, imaging, and tissue sampling.

UTI

Alternate name; see *Urinary Tract Infection*.

Utricle

A small balance organ in the inner ear that senses head position and movement in a straight line, such as forward, backward, or side-to-side motion.

Uvea

The middle layer of the eye, made up of the iris, ciliary body, and choroid. It controls the amount of light entering the eye, helps focus vision, and supplies blood to eye tissues.

Uveal Disease

A disorder of the iris, ciliary body, or choroid, including uveitis, tumors, vascular disease, and inflammation that may cause eye pain, photophobia, floaters, or visual loss.

Uveal Hypopigmentation

Reduced pigmentation in one or more parts of the uvea—the iris, ciliary body, or choroid. It may be sectoral or diffuse and can occur in inherited pigment disorders, including Waardenburg syndrome; effects on vision depend on the structures and extent involved.

Uveal Melanoma

The most common primary cancer inside the adult

eye. It begins in pigment-producing cells of the iris, ciliary body, or choroid and may cause visual changes or be found during an eye examination; it can spread to other organs.

Uveal Neoplasm

A tumor arising in the uveal tract of the eye—the iris, ciliary body, or choroid; malignant melanoma may threaten vision and spread to distant organs.

Uveitic Glaucoma

Glaucoma that develops in a person with uveitis, inflammation inside the eye. Inflammation, scarring, or steroid treatment can raise eye pressure and damage the optic nerve.

Alternate Names:
Inflammatory Glaucoma

Uveitis

Inflammation of the uvea, the middle layer of the eye that provides most of the blood supply to the retina and consists of the iris, ciliary body, and choroid. It can be caused by eye trauma, infections, or underlying autoimmune disorders that trigger inflammation throughout the body. Depending on which part of the eye is inflamed, uveitis can cause eye redness, deep aching pain, extreme sensitivity to light (photophobia), blurred vision, and dark floating spots (floaters), and can lead to permanent vision loss if not addressed.

Alternate Names:
Intraocular Inflammation; Iritis; Iridocyclitis; Choroiditis

Uveoparotid Fever

A form of sarcoidosis causing fever, swelling of both parotid glands near the ears, and inflammation in the front of the eyes. It may also cause facial-nerve weakness; treatment depends on the organs affected and severity.

UV Light

Ultraviolet radiation, an invisible part of sunlight or artificial light that can affect the skin and eyes and may cause sunburn, aging, or skin cancer.

Uvula

A small, soft flap hanging from the back of the roof of the mouth. It helps with swallowing and speech; swelling can cause gagging, pain, snoring, or difficulty breathing.

Uvulitis

Inflammation and swelling of the uvula, the small tissue hanging at the back of the throat. Infection, allergy, injury, dehydration, or irritation may cause it; severe swelling or breathing difficulty can threaten the airway.

Uvulopalatopharyngoplasty

An operation that removes or reshapes parts of the soft palate, the hanging uvula, and the throat to widen the breathing passage. It may help selected people with obstructive sleep apnea, but can cause pain, swallowing changes, bleeding, or recurrence.

U Wave

A small wave that may appear after the T wave on an electrocardiogram. A prominent U wave can occur with low potassium, a slow heart rate, or some medicines and is not specific to one cause.

V

Vaccination

Giving a vaccine to train the immune system to recognize a specific infection. Vaccination lowers the risk of illness, severe complications, and sometimes transmission; the recommended schedule depends on age, health, and local guidance.

Vaccination Schedule

A time-based plan for administering vaccines according to age, previous doses, medical conditions, exposure risks, and public-health guidance. Schedules vary by country and are updated as recommendations change.

Vaccinations/Immunizations During Pregnancy

Vaccines given during pregnancy are selected according to safety, disease risk, season, exposure, and local recommendations. Inactivated vaccines such as influenza and Tdap are commonly used when indicated, while some live vaccines are deferred until after pregnancy.

Vaccine

A biological preparation that elicits an active, protective, and pathogen-specific adaptive immune response to prevent, mitigate, or treat infectious diseases or malignant neoplasms. Formulations include live-attenuated microorganisms (e.g., MMR, varicella), inactivated whole pathogens (e.g., inactivated polio, hepatitis A), subunit and recombinant protein platforms (e.g., hepatitis B, HPV), toxoids (e.g., tetanus, diphtheria), polysaccharide-protein conjugates (e.g., pneumococcal conjugate), and messenger RNA (mRNA) encapsulated in lipid nanoparticles (e.g., SARS-CoV-2 mRNA vaccines). Vaccination induces antigen-specific humoral neutralizing antibody production by plasma cells and cell-mediated immunity with generation of long-lived memory B and T lymphocytes.

Alternate Names:
Vaccines; Immunization Agent

Vaccine Allergy

An immune reaction to a vaccine or one of its ingredients. It may cause hives, swelling, breathing difficulty, or, rarely, anaphylaxis. Soreness and redness at the injection site are common vaccine reactions, but are not usually allergies.

Vaccine-Associated Paralytic Poliomyelitis

A rare form of paralytic poliomyelitis associated with exposure to live, weakened poliovirus in oral polio vaccine. It can occur in a vaccine recipient or close contact when the vaccine strain regains neurovirulence. It is distinct from paralysis caused by circulating vaccine-derived poliovirus.

Alternate Names:
VAPP

Vaccines

Plural form; see *Vaccine*.

Vaccines and Immunizations

Vaccines train the immune system to recognize specific pathogens or toxins and reduce the risk of infection, severe disease, complications, and transmission.

Vaccinia

A virus used to make smallpox vaccines. Rare accidental infection can cause a sore at the contact site or more widespread illness, especially in people with weakened immunity.

Vaccinia Virus

Vaccinia virus is a poxvirus used to make smallpox vaccines and studied in some experimental cancer treatments; accidental infection is uncommon but possible.

VACTERL Association

The co-occurrence of congenital abnormalities in at least three of six areas: vertebrae, anus, heart, trachea and esophagus, kidneys, and limbs. The name comes from these features (vertebral defects, anal atresia, cardiac defects, tracheoesophageal fistula, renal anomalies, and limb abnormalities). It is identified from the pattern of abnormalities after evaluation for other diagnoses; there is no single confirmatory test.

Vacuum-Assisted Delivery

A vaginal birth assisted by a suction cup placed on the baby's scalp when labor is not progressing or the baby needs to be born promptly. It is used only when the cervix is fully open and the baby's position and head size are suitable. Possible complications include scalp injury, bleeding, or tears.

Vacuum Curettage

A procedure that removes tissue from the uterus using suction, commonly for uterine evacuation or endometrial sampling. Risks include bleeding, infection, retained tissue, and rarely uterine injury.

Vacuum Delivery

Assisted vaginal birth using a suction cup placed on the baby's scalp. It may be used when labor is not progressing or the baby needs to be born promptly and can cause scalp injury, bleeding, or tears.

Vacuum Erection Devices

Devices with a cylinder and pump that draw blood into the penis to produce an erection. A flexible ring may hold the erection during sex; bruising, numbness, or discomfort can occur, especially if the ring is left on too long.

Alternate Names:
Vacuum Erection Pump; Penis Pump

Vacuum Extractor

A cup-shaped device applied to the fetal scalp to assist vaginal delivery when specific maternal or fetal indications are present.

Vagabond's Disease

Older term for skin thickening (lichenification) and darkening caused by chronic body-louse infestation and repeated scratching. Changes often affect clothing-covered areas, including the waist, groin, thighs, and armpits. The term describes a skin manifestation of pediculosis corporis, not the infestation itself.

Alternate Names:
Parasitic Melanoderma

Vagal Maneuver

A physical action that affects the vagus nerve and can slow the heart's electrical activity. Examples include bearing down and, in clinical settings, certain pressure or cold-stimulation methods. These maneuvers may help assess or stop some fast heart rhythms.

Alternate Names:
Vagal Stimulation Technique; Parasympathetic Provocative Maneuver

Vagal Nerve Stimulation

Alternate name; see *Vagus Nerve Stimulation*.

Alternate Names:
VNS

Vagal Paraganglioma

A usually slow-growing tumor arising from nerve-related cells near the vagus nerve in the neck. It may cause a neck mass, hoarseness, swallowing difficulty, or nerve symptoms and can be identified with imaging and specialist assessment.

Vagina

A muscular, elastic canal connecting the cervix to the vaginal opening. It allows menstrual blood to leave the body, receives a penis or other objects during vaginal sex, and serves as the birth canal.

Vagina Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Vaginal Cancer*.

Vaginal Agenesis

A congenital condition in which the vagina is absent or underdeveloped. It often occurs with underdevelopment or absence of the uterus, as in Mayer-Rokitansky-Küster-Hauser syndrome. Renal, skeletal, or hearing differences may also occur, particularly in associated syndromes.

Vaginal Abscess

A pocket of pus in the vaginal wall or nearby tissue, usually caused by infection. It may cause a painful lump, swelling, fever, or discharge.

Vaginal Adhesions

Bands of scar tissue that make parts of the vaginal walls stick together. They may follow injury, surgery, radiation, or inflammation and can narrow the vaginal canal or cause pain.

Vaginal Adenosis

A patch of gland-like cells in the vaginal lining, where the lining is usually made of flat cells. It is often harmless and may occur after exposure to DES before birth; rarely, it is linked to clear-cell cancer of the vagina.

Vaginal Atresia

A birth condition in which part of the vaginal canal does not form an open passage, leaving a blocked segment. Menstrual blood may collect behind a complete blockage, causing absent periods and monthly pelvic pain.

Vaginal Atrophy

Thinning and reduced moisture of vaginal tissues, usually related to lower estrogen after menopause or other hormone changes. It can cause dryness, burning, itching, pain during sex, or urinary symptoms. The broader term genitourinary syndrome of menopause also includes vulvar and urinary symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Atrophic Vaginitis; Vulvovaginal Atrophy

Vaginal Bleeding

Unexpected, unusually heavy, or prolonged bleeding from the vagina, including bleeding between periods, after sexual intercourse, during pregnancy, or after menopause. Causes include hormonal changes, infection, pregnancy-related conditions, structural lesions, medications, and cancer.

Vaginal Bleeding Between Periods

Bleeding between menstrual periods may result from contraception, infection, pregnancy, polyps, fibroids, hormonal changes, or cancer. Persistent or heavy bleeding can have a serious cause.

Vaginal Bleeding During Early Pregnancy

Bleeding from the vagina during the first part of pregnancy can result from cervical changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, infection, or other conditions. A small amount may occur without a serious cause, but bleeding with heavy loss, severe or one-sided pain, shoulder pain, dizziness, or fainting can indicate a serious problem.

Vaginal Bleeding During Late Pregnancy

Bleeding from the vagina later in pregnancy may be caused by placenta previa, placental separation, labor, cervical disease, or other complications. Significant bleeding can be a serious pregnancy complication.

Vaginal Bleeding In Early Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Vaginal Bleeding During Early Pregnancy*.

Vaginal Bleeding In Late Pregnancy

Alternate name; see *Vaginal Bleeding During Late Pregnancy*.

Vaginal Bleeding In Pregnancy

Bleeding from the vagina during pregnancy. Causes vary with the stage of pregnancy and include cervical changes, miscarriage, ectopic pregnancy, placental disorders, labor, and other conditions; see *Vaginal Bleeding During Early Pregnancy* and *Vaginal Bleeding During Late Pregnancy*.

Vaginal Cancer

A rare malignancy originating in the tissues of the vagina, most commonly squamous cell carcinoma arising from the surface epithelial lining, and less frequently adenocarcinoma or melanoma. It may manifest as abnormal vaginal bleeding (especially postmenopausal or postcoital), watery discharge, pelvic pain, or a palpable vaginal mass.

Alternate Names:
Vaginal Carcinoma; Malignant Vaginal Neoplasm

Vaginal Candidiasis

Alternate name; see *Vulvovaginal Candidiasis*.

Vaginal Cuff

The upper end of the vagina that is closed with stitches after the uterus is removed during a hysterectomy.

Vaginal Cuff Dehiscence

An opening of the stitched upper end of the vagina after hysterectomy. It may cause pelvic pain, bleeding, discharge, or tissue bulging through the opening.

Vaginal Cysts

Fluid-filled or tissue-lined sacs in the vaginal wall. Most are harmless and cause no symptoms, but some cause a lump, pressure, pain, or problems with intercourse. Types include inclusion cysts and Gartner duct cysts.

Vaginal Inclusion Cyst

A small sac in the vaginal wall containing trapped surface-lining cells and material. It may form after childbirth, surgery, or another injury and is usually harmless unless it becomes large, painful, or infected.

Vaginal Dilator

A smooth device used to gently stretch or keep open the vaginal canal when it has become narrow or short because of scarring, surgery, radiation, or a difference present from birth.

Vaginal Discharge

Vaginal discharge may be normal or may indicate infection, inflammation, hormonal change, or another condition. Normal discharge is usually clear to whitish and odourless and varies with the menstrual cycle, pregnancy, sexual arousal, and some contraceptives.

Vaginal Dryness

Reduced vaginal lubrication, commonly associated with menopause, breastfeeding, hormonal changes, medications, or irritation. It may cause discomfort, itching, painful intercourse, or minor bleeding.

Vaginal Endometriosis

Endometriosis affecting the vaginal wall, where tissue like the lining of the uterus grows outside the uterus. It may cause pain during sex, a tender lump, or bleeding that worsens around menstrual periods.

Vaginal Dysplasia

Alternate name; see *Vaginal Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Vaginal Fistula

An abnormal passage between the vagina and another organ, commonly the bladder or rectum. It may cause continuous urine or stool leakage, infection, skin irritation, and emotional distress.

Vaginal Foreign Body

An object retained in the vagina, most often a tampon or other inserted material. It may cause discharge, odor, bleeding, pain, or infection.

Vaginal Granulation Tissue

Soft, red healing tissue that grows at a vaginal

wound, often at the top of the vagina after hysterectomy. It may cause spotting or discharge while the area heals.

Vaginal Herpes

Herpes simplex infection affecting the vagina or nearby genital tissue; see *Genital Herpes*.

Vaginal Human Papillomavirus Infection

Human papillomavirus infection affecting the vaginal lining; see *Human Papillomavirus Infection*.

Vaginal Fornix

One of the recesses surrounding the cervix where the vagina meets the cervix. The posterior fornix is adjacent to the peritoneal cul-de-sac and is relevant in pelvic examination and some procedures.

Vaginal Fusion And Duplication

Birth-related differences in which the vaginal canal is partly joined, divided, or duplicated. They may occur with abnormalities of the uterus, cervix, urinary tract, or external genitalia and may cause obstruction, pain, menstrual problems, or difficulty with intercourse.

Vaginal Health

Vaginal health includes normal vaginal tissues, fluids, microorganisms, and comfort. Persistent odor, itching, pain, bleeding, or unusual discharge can indicate infection or another condition.

Vaginal Hematoma

A collection of blood within the vaginal wall or surrounding tissues, usually caused by childbirth, trauma, or surgery and potentially producing severe pain, swelling, or blood loss.

Vaginal Hemorrhage

Heavy or severe bleeding that exits through the vagina. The blood may come from the vagina, cervix, uterus, or a pregnancy-related source; the term describes the bleeding and does not identify its cause. It may occur with childbirth, pregnancy complications, or injury and can cause major blood loss.

Vaginal Hypoplasia

Vaginal hypoplasia is underdevelopment of the vagina, usually present from birth. It may occur with other reproductive or urinary-tract differences and can affect menstruation, sexual function, or fertility.

Vaginal Hysterectomy

Surgical removal of the uterus through the vagina. It may be used for selected benign uterine conditions and usually avoids an abdominal incision, although suitability depends on anatomy and disease.

Vaginal Inflammation

Alternate name; see *Vaginitis*.

Vaginal Intercourse

Sexual activity involving insertion into the vagina, commonly of a penis or sex toy. Pregnancy can result when sperm enter the vagina.

Vaginal Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Abnormal squamous cells confined to the vaginal lining, often associated with persistent human papillomavirus infection. Low-grade changes often regress; high-grade changes (VaIN 2 or 3) are precancerous and may progress to vaginal cancer. It is not invasive cancer.

Vaginal Intraepithelial Cysts

An imprecise name sometimes used for small cysts in the vaginal lining; see *Vaginal Inclusion Cyst*.

Alternate Names:
VaIN; Vaginal Dysplasia

Vaginal Introitus

The entrance to the vagina. It is part of the external genital area and may be examined when assessing pain, infection, injury, scarring, or pelvic-floor problems.

Vaginal Itching

Itching or irritation in or around the vagina, often

involving the vulva. Causes include candidiasis, some sexually transmitted infections, dermatitis, hormonal changes, and other conditions; bacterial vaginosis more often causes odor or discharge than itching.

Vaginal Laceration

A tear in the vaginal tissue, often caused by childbirth, sexual activity, trauma, or a medical procedure. It may cause pain, swelling, or bleeding.

Vaginal Leiomyoma

A rare, usually noncancerous growth of smooth muscle in the vaginal wall. It may cause a lump, pressure, pain, or problems with urination or intercourse.

Vaginal Lubrication

Natural moisture made by the vaginal tissues and nearby glands. It usually increases with sexual arousal and may decrease with hormonal changes, some medicines, illness, or irritation.

Vaginal Membrane

A thin fold of tissue associated with the vagina. The term may refer to the hymen at the vaginal opening or to an abnormal membrane that blocks the vaginal canal.

Vaginal Microbiome

The community of microorganisms living in the vagina. Many healthy vaginal microbiomes are dominated by Lactobacillus species, which help maintain an acidic environment; changes in the community can be associated with bacterial vaginosis and other conditions.

Vaginal Melanoma

A very rare cancer that begins in pigment-producing cells in the vaginal lining. It may cause bleeding, discharge, or a lump and can be dark or have little color.

Vaginal Mucosa

The moist inner lining of the vagina. It contains folds that allow the vaginal canal to stretch and helps protect the tissue.

Vaginal Odor

An unusual or unpleasant odor from vaginal discharge that may result from bacterial vaginosis, infection, retained material, hormonal changes, or other conditions.

Vaginal Opening

The external entrance to the vagina. It is part of the vulvar vestibule and may be affected by infection, inflammation, trauma, scarring, or congenital variation.

Vaginal Pessary

A removable device placed in the vagina to support the vaginal walls or nearby pelvic organs, usually for pelvic-organ prolapse or some forms of urine leakage.

Vaginal pH

A measure of how acidic the vagina is. The vaginal environment is normally mildly acidic, and the pH can change with hormones, semen, blood, medicines, or infection.

Vaginal Prolapse

Downward bulging of a vaginal wall because the tissues supporting the vagina have weakened. The bulge may involve the bladder, rectum, or the top of the vagina after hysterectomy.

Vaginal Rugae

Soft folds in the inner lining of the vagina that allow it to stretch and return toward its usual shape.

Vaginal Seeding

Placing vaginal fluid on a baby born by cesarean section in an attempt to expose the baby to the parent's vaginal microorganisms. Clear health benefits have not been established, and harmful infections may be transmitted.

Vaginal Septum

A wall of tissue that divides or crosses the vaginal canal and is usually present from birth. It may cause pain, trouble inserting tampons, or blocked menstrual flow; see *Longitudinal Vaginal Septum* and *Transverse Vaginal Septum*.

Vaginal Sarcoma

A very rare cancer arising from muscle or other supporting tissue in the vaginal wall. Its symptoms may include bleeding, discharge, pain, or a lump; the type is identified by examining a tissue sample.

Vaginal Speculum

An instrument inserted into the vagina and gently opened to separate the vaginal walls and visualize the vagina and cervix. It may be used for pelvic examination, cervical cytology such as a Pap test, swab collection, assessment of bleeding or discharge, and selected procedures. Size and design are chosen according to anatomy, comfort, and the clinical purpose.

Vaginal Stenosis

Narrowing or shortening of the vaginal canal, which may result from surgery, radiation, scarring, inflammation, trauma, or congenital development. It can cause pain, difficult examination, or difficulty with penetration.

Vaginal Swab

A sample of fluid or cells collected from the vagina for laboratory testing, often to look for infection or other changes.

Vaginal Trauma

Injury to the vaginal tissues caused by childbirth, sexual activity, foreign objects, procedures, or blunt or penetrating trauma. It may cause bleeding, pain, swelling, or urinary symptoms; severe bleeding or deep injury can be serious.

Vaginal Ultrasound Probe

A specialized endocavitary ultrasound transducer used through the vagina to produce images of the uterus, cervix, ovaries, nearby pelvic structures, or an early pregnancy. It sends and receives sound waves and does not use ionizing radiation.

Alternate Names:
Endovaginal Transducer Transvaginal Ultrasound Transducer

Vaginal Vault Prolapse

Descent of the top of the vagina into or through the vaginal opening, usually after removal of the uterus. It may cause pelvic pressure, a bulge, backache, or difficulty emptying the bladder or bowel.

Alternate Names:
Post-Hysterectomy Vault Prolapse

Vaginal Vestibule

The space of the vulva between the labia minora that contains the external openings of the urethra and vagina and the ducts of the greater and lesser vestibular glands.

Vaginal Wall

The layers of muscle, connective tissue, and moist lining that form the walls of the vaginal canal.

Vaginal Ulceration

One or more open sores in the vaginal lining. Causes include infection, inflammation, injury, and cancer; the appearance alone does not identify the cause.

Vaginal Yeast Infection

Alternate name; see *Vulvovaginal Candidiasis*.

Vagina Neoplasm

An abnormal growth in the vagina that may be benign, precancerous, or cancerous. It can cause bleeding, discharge, pain, or a lump, although early growths may cause no symptoms.

Vaginectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the vagina, usually to treat selected cancers or severe disease; effects may include changes in sexual function, fertility, urination, and bowel function.

Vaginismus

Alternate name; see *Genito-Pelvic Pain/Penetration Disorder*.

Vaginitis

Inflammation or irritation of the vagina that may cause discharge, itching, burning, odor, pain, or discomfort with urination or sex. Causes include infections, hormones, chemicals, allergies, and tissue dryness.

Vaginoplasty

Vaginoplasty is surgery to create, repair, or reshape the vagina. It may be performed for congenital differences, injury, cancer treatment, pelvic-floor problems, or gender-affirming care.

Vaginospasm

Alternate name; see *Genito-Pelvic Pain/Penetration Disorder*.

Vagotomy

Surgery that cuts selected branches of the vagus nerve to reduce signals that stimulate stomach acid and movement. It was once used for difficult stomach ulcers but is now uncommon because medicines and less invasive treatments are available.

Vagus Nerve

The tenth cranial nerve, carrying signals between the brain and the heart, lungs, throat, voice box, and digestive tract. It helps regulate heart rate, breathing, swallowing, voice, and digestion.

Vagus Nerve Stimulation

A treatment that sends regular, mild electrical pulses to the vagus nerve through an implanted device in the chest or, in some settings, a handheld device. It is used for selected epilepsy, treatment-resistant depression, and other conditions; benefits may take time and side effects can include voice change, cough, or throat discomfort.

Valacyclovir

An antiviral medicine that the body changes into acyclovir to stop herpes viruses from multiplying. It treats cold sores, genital herpes, and shingles; accumulation in kidney disease can cause nervous-system effects.

Valganciclovir

An antiviral medicine used mainly to prevent or treat cytomegalovirus infection after transplantation. The body changes it into ganciclovir, which blocks viral multiplication; it can lower blood counts, injure the kidneys, affect fertility, and harm a fetus.

Valgus

A limb or joint position in which the part farther from the body's center is angled outward. Examples include knock-knees and hallux valgus (bunion deformity).

Valgus Stress Test

A clinical examination that applies a valgus force to a joint to assess its medial ligaments. It is used most often to assess the medial collateral ligament of the knee and the ulnar collateral ligament of the elbow; pain or increased joint opening may indicate injury.

Valinemia

A rare inherited condition in which the body cannot process the amino acid valine normally. High valine levels may cause feeding problems, low muscle tone, developmental delay, or other nervous-system symptoms.

Valley Fever

The common name for coccidioidomycosis, a fungal infection caused by Coccidioides species and acquired by inhaling airborne spores from soil. It usually causes a mild respiratory illness but can disseminate to skin, bone, joints, or meninges, especially in people at higher risk.

Valproate

A term for valproic acid and related medicines, including sodium valproate and divalproex sodium. These medicines treat some seizure disorders and mood disorders; adverse effects include liver or pan-

creatic injury, blood-cell changes, weight gain, and serious fetal developmental harm.

Valproate Toxicity

Harm from an overdose or other excessive exposure to valproate. It may cause sleepiness, vomiting, low blood pressure, slowed breathing, or coma; high ammonia, liver injury, and metabolic abnormalities may also occur.

Valproic Acid

A medicine used for certain seizures, bipolar disorder, and migraine prevention. It can cause liver injury, pancreatitis, birth defects, and developmental harm during pregnancy.

Valproic Acid Toxicity

Alternate name; see *Valproate Toxicity*.

Valrubicin

A chemotherapy medicine placed directly into the bladder for selected bladder cancers that have not responded adequately to other treatment. It can cause bladder irritation, blood in the urine, infection, and, rarely, effects throughout the body.

Valsalva

Alternate name; see *Valsalva Maneuver*.

Valsalva Maneuver

Forceful expiration against a closed airway, often performed by bearing down. It changes pressure in the chest and affects heart rate and blood pressure; the maneuver is used in selected examinations and procedures.

Valsalva Retinopathy

Bleeding in front of the retina, usually near the center of vision, after a sudden rise in pressure from actions such as coughing, vomiting, or straining. The amount and location of bleeding can affect vision.

Valsalva's Manoeuvre

Alternate spelling; see *Valsalva Maneuver*.

Valsartan

Valsartan is an angiotensin-II receptor blocker used for hypertension, heart failure, and selected cardiovascular indications; hyperkalaemia, renal-function changes, hypotension, and fetal toxicity are important risks.

Valve Repair Surgery

Reconstructive surgery performed to preserve and repair a native heart valve rather than replacing it with a prosthesis; see *Heart Valve Surgery* and *Mitral-Valve Repair*.

Valves

Structures that permit fluid or blood to move predominantly in one direction and prevent backward flow; cardiac valves and venous valves are important examples.

Valvotomy

Surgical or catheter-based division of narrowed valve tissue to improve blood flow, most often performed for selected stenotic heart valves.

Valvulae Conniventes

Permanent circular folds of the small intestine's mucosa and submucosa, most prominent in the jejunum. They increase the surface area available for absorption and remain visible when the intestine stretches.

Alternate Names:
Plicae Circulares; Kerckring Folds

Valvular Disease

Alternate term; see *Heart Valve Disease*.

Valvular Endocarditis

Alternate name; see *Endocarditis*.

Valvular Heart Disease

A broad spectrum of structural and functional disorders affecting one or more of the four cardiac valves (aortic, mitral, tricuspid, pulmonic), classified hemodynamically as valvular stenosis (narrowing and outflow obstruction) or valvular regurgitation

(insufficiency and backward flow).

Alternate Names:
VHD

Valvular Insufficiency

Incomplete closure of a heart valve, allowing blood to leak backward when the heart contracts or relaxes. It can affect the mitral, aortic, tricuspid, or pulmonary valve and may eventually strain the heart.

Valvuloplasty

A procedure used to widen or repair a narrowed or abnormal heart valve, by balloon catheter or open surgery depending on the valve and condition.

Valvulotomy

A procedure that cuts open a narrowed heart valve to improve blood flow. It may be performed with a catheter or surgery; the valve can leak afterward and narrowing may recur.

Vancomycin

An antibiotic used for selected serious bacterial infections and, by mouth, for certain infections of the large intestine. Adverse effects include infusion reactions, kidney injury, hearing problems, and low blood counts.

Vancomycin Infusion Reaction

A rate-related reaction during intravenous vancomycin administration, usually causing flushing, warmth, itching, or redness of the face, neck, and upper body. It is generally not an allergic reaction.

Alternate Names:
Vancomycin Flushing Reaction

Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococcus

Enterococcus bacteria that are resistant to vancomycin, usually because of altered cell-wall precursors. VRE can cause healthcare-associated urinary, bloodstream, wound, or other infections; resistance patterns affect which antibiotics are effective.

Van der Woude Syndrome

An inherited condition, usually with autosomal dominant inheritance, that commonly causes small pits in the lower lip and cleft lip with or without cleft palate, or cleft palate alone. Most cases are associated with pathogenic variants in *IRF6*; a smaller number are linked to *GRHL3*.

Alternate Names:
VWS; Lip-Pit Syndrome

Vandetanib

A targeted cancer medicine used for selected medullary thyroid cancers. It blocks signals that help cancer cells grow and blood vessels form; adverse effects include diarrhea, high blood pressure, skin changes, and dangerous heart-rhythm changes.

Vaping

Vaping uses an electronic device to heat a liquid and produce an aerosol for inhalation. Aerosols may contain nicotine and other substances that can harm the lungs and cause dependence.

Vaporiser

A device that converts a liquid medicine or volatile substance into a vapor for inhalation or controlled delivery, such as in anesthesia.

Variable Decelerations

Brief drops in a baby's heart rate that vary in timing and shape, often caused by pressure on the umbilical cord during labor. Occasional drops may be harmless, while frequent or prolonged drops can indicate reduced fetal oxygenation.

Variant Angina Pectoris

Chest pain caused by temporary spasm of a coronary artery, often occurring at rest or at night. Episodes can cause temporary myocardial ischemia and may trigger dangerous arrhythmias or myocardial infarction.

Alternate Names:
Prinzmetal Angina; Vasospastic Angina

Variant CJD

A rare prion disease linked to eating food contaminated with the agent that causes bovine spongiform encephalopathy in cattle. It differs from classic Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease in its typical age, early symptoms, and tissue findings.

Variant Classification

The process of estimating whether a genetic change is harmless, uncertain, or likely to cause disease. Specialists use laboratory evidence, family history, population data, and the person's clinical findings.

Varibaculum Cambriense

A bacterial species in the genus Varibaculum reported from human clinical specimens. Its significance depends on the specimen, clinical findings, and antimicrobial susceptibility pattern.

Variceal Band Ligation

A procedure using a flexible camera to place small bands around enlarged veins in the food pipe. The bands stop blood flow through the veins and are used to control or prevent bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Endoscopic Variceal Ligation; EVL

Variceal Hemorrhage

Severe bleeding from enlarged, fragile veins in the esophagus or stomach, usually caused by high pressure in the liver's blood vessels. It can cause vomiting blood, black stools, shock, and death.

Alternate Names:
Variceal Bleeding

Varicella

An acute, highly contagious primary infection with varicella-zoster virus that causes fever and a generalized itchy, fluid-filled rash. It is usually mild in children but can cause pneumonia or encephalitis, especially in adults, pregnant people, infants, and people with weakened immunity.

Alternate Names:
Chickenpox

Varicella-Zoster Virus

The virus that causes chickenpox and shingles. After chickenpox, it can remain inactive in nerve tissue and reactivate years later as a painful, blistering rash called shingles.

Varicellovirus

Varicellovirus is a genus of herpesviruses that includes varicella-zoster virus, the cause of chickenpox and shingles.

Varices

Abnormally enlarged, twisted veins. Varices in the esophagus or stomach are often caused by portal hypertension; varicose veins in the legs are usually related to impaired vein-valve function.

Varicocele

Enlarged veins in the bundle that drains blood from a testicle, usually on the left side of the scrotum. It may feel like a soft, tangled mass and can cause a dull ache, reduced growth of the affected testicle, or lower sperm production. Many varicoceles cause no symptoms or fertility problems.

Varicocele Embolization

A procedure that uses a thin tube to place coils or another material in enlarged scrotal veins. This blocks abnormal backward blood flow and reduces pressure in the veins.

Varicose Ulcer

An open sore near the ankle caused by long-term poor drainage through the leg veins. It may be surrounded by swelling, varicose veins, or skin discoloration and can heal slowly or recur.

Varicose Vein

An enlarged, swollen, and twisting vein that lies just beneath the surface of the skin, most frequently occurring in the legs and feet. It develops when the tiny one-way valves inside veins weaken or fail, allowing blood to flow backward and pool rather than flowing efficiently toward the heart. Over time, the pooled blood stretches the vein walls, causing visible blue or dark purple bulging veins that can

cause aching, heaviness, swelling, and throbbing in the legs.

Alternate Names:
Varicose Veins; Varicosis; Varicosities

Varicose Veins

Plural form; see *Varicose Vein*.

Varicose Veins and Venous Insufficiency

Enlarged superficial veins and inadequate return of blood from the legs because venous valves or the vein wall do not work effectively. Aching, heaviness, swelling, skin discoloration, dermatitis, and ulcers may occur.

Varicose Veins (Spider Veins)

Related terms, not synonyms: varicose veins are enlarged, often bulging veins; spider veins are smaller dilated vessels near the skin. See *Varicose Vein* and *Spider Veins*.

Variegate Porphyria

An inherited disorder of heme production that can cause attacks of abdominal pain, vomiting, nerve symptoms, confusion, or dark urine and can also cause fragile, blistering skin after sunlight exposure.

Variola

A highly contagious and deadly disease caused by variola virus, eradicated globally by 1980 through vaccination. See *Smallpox*.

Varix

An abnormally dilated, tortuous vein; multiple varices commonly occur in portal hypertension or chronic venous disease.

Varus

A limb or joint deformity in which the part farther from the body bends inward, toward the body's center line. Examples include bowlegs and some inward-turning foot deformities.

Varus Stress Test

A clinical examination that applies a varus force to a joint to assess its lateral ligaments. It is used most often to assess the lateral collateral ligament of the knee and the lateral ligament complex of the elbow; pain or increased joint opening may indicate injury.

Vas

A duct or vessel; in reproductive anatomy, the vas deferens transports sperm from the epididymis toward the ejaculatory duct.

Vasa Deferentia

Alternate name; see *Vas Deferens*.

Vasa Efferentia

Small ducts that carry sperm from the rete testis to the epididymis, where sperm mature. They also reabsorb fluid from the testicular ducts.

Vasa Previa

An obstetric condition in which unprotected fetal blood vessels run within the membranes over or close to the internal cervical opening, commonly because of velamentous umbilical cord insertion or vessels connecting separate placental lobes. The vessels may rupture when the membranes break or labor begins, causing rapid fetal hemorrhage. Unlike placenta previa, the vessels rather than placental tissue lie over or near the opening.

Vasa Recta

Long, hairpin-shaped blood vessels in the inner part of the kidney. They run beside the loops of Henle and help the kidneys concentrate urine.

Vasa Vasorum

Small blood vessels in the walls of large arteries and veins. They supply oxygen and nutrients to the outer parts of these vessel walls.

Vascular

Relating to blood vessels or, sometimes, lymphatic vessels. Vascular conditions include narrowed or blocked arteries, aneurysms, blood clots, abnormal vessel connections, and problems with veins; the

term may also describe tests, surgery, or medicines involving these vessels.

Vascular Access

A route into a blood vessel for medicines, fluids, blood tests, monitoring, or dialysis. It may be a short-term catheter, a surgically joined artery and vein, or a synthetic graft, depending on the purpose and expected duration.

Vascular Access For Hemodialysis

A route that allows blood to leave the body and return during dialysis. It may be a joined artery and vein, a synthetic graft, or a large vein catheter; each has different risks of infection, clotting, and failure.

Vascular Balloon Catheter

An inflatable balloon mounted at the distal tip of a flexible vascular catheter used to dilate stenotic or occluded blood vessels during angioplasty, deliver and expand endovascular stents, or temporarily occlude vascular flow.

Alternate Names:
Angioplasty Balloon; Vascular Balloon Dilator; Balloon Catheter

Vascular Bed

The network of blood vessels supplying a particular organ or tissue. Its vessels widen or narrow to adjust blood flow according to the tissue's needs.

Vascular Bypass

Surgery that uses a vein or artificial tube to carry blood around a blocked part of an artery and restore blood flow.

Alternate Names:
Surgical Bypass; Bypass Grafting; Arterial Bypass Graft

Vascular Claudication

Alternate name; see *Claudication*.

Vascular Clip

A small device placed during a procedure to close or control a blood vessel. It may stop bleeding, prevent blood flow to a selected area, or secure a vessel permanently.

Alternate Names:
Hemostatic Clip; Surgical Vessel Clip; Ligation Clip

Vascular Compliance

The change in a blood vessel's volume in response to a change in pressure. More compliant vessels expand more for a given pressure increase.

Vascular Complications

Problems involving blood vessels after disease, injury, or a procedure, such as bleeding, hematoma, thrombosis, embolism, vessel injury, or reduced blood flow to a limb. Symptoms and urgency depend on the vessel and tissue affected.

Vascular Dementia

A decline in thinking and daily function caused by cerebrovascular injury or disease. It can follow a stroke or develop as small-vessel damage accumulates. Multi-infarct dementia is one subtype of vascular dementia, not an equivalent term.

Alternate Names:
VaD

Vascular Disease

A disorder of arteries, veins, or lymphatic vessels. Examples include atherosclerosis, aneurysms, peripheral artery disease, venous thrombosis, varicose veins, and vasculitis.

Vascular Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome

A rare inherited connective-tissue disorder that makes arteries and hollow organs unusually fragile. Features can include thin translucent skin, easy bruising, and a risk of spontaneous blood-vessel or bowel rupture.

Alternate Names:
vEDS; Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome Type IV

Vascular Embolic Particles

Small materials placed in a blood vessel during a procedure to block blood flow. They may be used

to control bleeding or reduce blood flow to a tumor, fibroid, or other abnormal area.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Embolization Particle

Vascular Embolization

Intentional blockage of a blood vessel with material delivered through a catheter. It may stop bleeding, reduce blood flow to a tumor, or close an aneurysm or abnormal vessel connection.

Alternate Names:
Catheter Embolization; Therapeutic Embolization

Vascular Embolization Coil

A catheter-delivered wire device used to block selected blood vessels, often to treat aneurysms or bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Coil

Vascular Embolization Plug

A device delivered through a catheter to block a selected blood vessel during image-guided embolization, for example to control bleeding or close an abnormal vessel.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Occlusion Plug; Embolization Plug

Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor

A protein that helps new blood vessels form and makes blood vessels more leaky. Some medicines block it to treat certain eye diseases and cancers.

Alternate Names:
VEGF; Vascular Permeability Factor

Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks vascular endothelial growth factor, a protein that helps blood vessels grow. These medicines are used for some cancers and eye diseases involving abnormal new blood vessels.

Alternate Names:
Anti-VEGF Agent

Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor Inhibitors

Alternate name; see *Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor Inhibitor*.

Vascular Forceps

Surgical forceps designed to grasp blood vessels or related tissue during vascular procedures. Their jaws are shaped to limit crushing or tearing of delicate vessels.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Surgical Forceps

Vascular Graft

A tube used to replace or bypass a damaged or blocked blood vessel. It may be made from a person's vein or from a synthetic material; possible problems include infection, bleeding, narrowing, or a clot blocking the graft.

Vascular Graft Patency

The continued openness and useful blood flow through a blood-vessel graft or bypass. A clot, narrowing, infection, or scar growth can block it, so examination and sometimes ultrasound are used for monitoring.

Vascular Hemostat

A surgical clamp used to temporarily occlude a blood vessel and control bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Clamp; Atraumatic Hemostasis Forceps

Vascular Imaging

Tests that show blood vessels and sometimes measure blood flow. Ultrasound, CT, MRI, or catheter-based imaging can find narrowing, blockage, aneurysm, dissection, clot, bleeding, or abnormal vessels; the safest test depends on the body area, urgency, kidney function, and contrast risks.

Vascularity

The amount and arrangement of blood vessels supplying a tissue or growth. A highly vascular area may heal or bleed differently and may look different on imaging; blood supply can also affect some

treatments.

Vascular Laser Therapy

A treatment that uses laser energy to close or change selected blood vessels. The laser may be applied through the skin or through a thin tube.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Laser Treatment

Vascular Ligation

Surgical tying, clipping, or sealing of a blood vessel to stop bleeding or redirect blood flow. It may be used during surgery or to treat selected abnormal vessels.

Alternate Names:
Vessel Clipping

Vascular Malformation

A blood-vessel or lymph-vessel structure that developed abnormally before birth. It may cause a skin mark, swelling, pain, bleeding, or pressure on nearby organs; effects depend on its type and location.

Vascular Needle Holder

A surgical instrument used to hold and guide fine suture needles during repair of blood vessels. It permits precise stitches while minimizing crushing or tearing of delicate vessel walls.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Suturing Needle Holder

Vascular Neurology

The neurology subspecialty focused on cerebrovascular disorders, including ischemic stroke, brain hemorrhage, and transient ischemic attack. It addresses the neurologic effects of impaired or abnormal blood flow to the brain and the vascular causes of stroke and related conditions.

Vascular Pain

Pain caused by impaired blood flow, often appearing in a limb with exertion as claudication or, in more severe disease, at rest.

Vascular Patch Graft

A piece of biological or synthetic material sewn onto a blood vessel to widen or repair it.

Alternate Names:
Angioplasty Patch

Vascular Retraction

To pull a vessel or tissue away from an operative field using a surgical retractor.

Alternate Names:
Vessel Retraction; Surgical Vessel Exposure

Vascular Ring

A birth defect in which blood vessels around the heart form a ring that can press on the windpipe or food pipe. It may cause noisy breathing, cough, repeated chest infections, swallowing difficulty, or feeding problems. Some people need no treatment; symptomatic rings may require surgery.

Vascular Scissors

A surgical instrument with two blades used to cut tissue, sutures, dressings, or other materials during vascular procedures.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Surgical Scissors

Vascular Shunt

A surgically created or implanted pathway that redirects blood or another fluid from one vessel or body space to another.

Alternate Names:
Bypass Shunt

Vascular Sponge

A sterile absorbent material used during blood-vessel procedures to absorb blood, apply pressure, or protect delicate tissue.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Laparotomy Sponge

Vascular Staple

A small metal or polymer device used to close tissue or join selected blood-vessel structures. It provides rapid closure but can cause narrowing, bleeding,

thrombosis, or tissue injury if unsuitable or misplaced.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Surgical Staple; Vessel Closure Device

Vascular Stent

A small mesh or tube placed inside a narrowed or blocked vessel to help keep it open.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Stent

Vascular Stent Balloon

A balloon on a catheter used to expand a vascular stent against the vessel wall and restore an open channel. Inflation can cause vessel injury, bleeding, clotting, or rarely rupture.

Alternate Names:
Stent-Expansion Balloon

Vascular Stent-Graft

A fabric-covered metal frame placed inside a blood vessel to reinforce a weak wall or seal an aneurysm, tear, or leak. Follow-up imaging checks for movement, blockage, or leakage around the graft.

Alternate Names:
Endovascular Graft; Aortic Stent-Graft

Vascular Suction

A suction device used during a vascular procedure to remove blood or other fluid from the operative field.

Alternate Names:
Vascular Suction Cannula; Frazier Suction

Vascular Surgery

Operations that repair, widen, replace, or reroute blood vessels to restore circulation or prevent bleeding. Procedures may treat aneurysms, blocked arteries, blood-vessel injuries, or problems with veins and dialysis access.

Vascular System

The network of arteries, veins, and capillaries that carries blood throughout the body. It delivers oxygen, nutrients, and hormones to tissues and carries carbon dioxide and other waste products away. Disease may narrow, weaken, block, or inflame these vessels.

Vascular Thrombectomy

Removal of a blood clot from a blood vessel using surgery or a catheter-based procedure. The aim is to restore blood flow and protect tissue from damage when a clot blocks an important artery or vein.

Alternate Names:
Clot Extraction

Vascular Tissue Adhesive

A liquid material delivered through a catheter to block selected blood vessels during image-guided embolization. It may be used to control bleeding, close an abnormal vessel, or reduce blood flow to a tumor.

Alternate Names:
Cyanoacrylate Embolization Glue; Endovascular Embolic Adhesive

Vascular Tone

The usual degree of tightening in the muscle within blood-vessel walls. It helps control vessel width, blood flow, and blood pressure.

Vascular Trauma

Injury to an artery or vein from blunt or penetrating trauma, a crush injury, or a medical procedure. It can cause bleeding, a clot, or reduced blood flow to tissues supplied by the vessel.

Vascular Ulcer

A persistent open wound caused or maintained by poor blood flow, high pressure in the veins, loss of protective feeling, or another blood-vessel problem. It usually affects the legs or feet and may heal slowly or become infected.

Vasculitic Neuropathy

Nerve damage caused by inflammation of the small blood vessels that supply nerves. It often causes painful, uneven numbness or weakness and may affect several limbs as the vessel inflammation con-

tinues.

Vasculitis

A diverse group of autoimmune conditions characterized by inflammation of the blood vessel walls. When blood vessels become inflamed, their walls can thicken, weaken, narrow, or develop scars, restricting normal blood circulation to downstream tissues and organs. Depending on which organs and blood vessels are affected, vasculitis can cause symptoms ranging from fever, fatigue, and weight loss to skin rashes, nerve weakness, kidney dysfunction, and lung problems.

Alternate Names:
Angiitis; Blood Vessel Inflammation; Systemic Vasculitis

Vas Deferens

A muscular tube that carries sperm from the epididymis toward the ejaculatory duct during ejaculation.

Vasectomy

A permanent contraceptive procedure in which the vas deferens are divided or occluded to prevent sperm from entering the ejaculate. It does not immediately provide sterility and does not protect against sexually transmitted infections.

Vasectomy Reversal

Surgery to restore sperm flow after vasectomy by reconnecting the cut ends of the vas deferens or connecting it to the epididymis. These operations are called vasovasostomy and vasoepididymostomy; pregnancy is not guaranteed.

Vasoactive Intestinal Peptide Test

A blood test measuring a hormone that affects the intestine and blood vessels. It is used mainly when a rare hormone-producing tumor is suspected in someone with severe watery diarrhea, dehydration, or abnormal body salts.

Vasoconstriction

Narrowing of blood vessels caused by contraction of vascular smooth muscle, which can raise blood pressure or reduce blood flow to affected tissues.

Vasoconstrictor

A substance that narrows blood vessels by making their muscle walls contract. This can raise blood pressure and reduce local blood flow; vasoconstrictor medicines are used in selected emergencies and with local anesthetics.

Vasoconstrictors

Alternate name; see *Vasoconstrictor*.

Vasodepressor Syncope

Fainting caused mainly by sudden widening of blood vessels and a fall in blood pressure. It often occurs as part of a vasovagal reaction and may be preceded by nausea, sweating, warmth, or lightheadedness.

Vasodilatation

Alternate spelling; see *Vasodilation*.

Vasodilation

Widening of blood vessels when their muscular walls relax. It can increase blood flow and lower blood pressure and occurs with exercise, heat, medicines, and inflammation.

Vasodilator

A substance that relaxes blood-vessel walls and makes the vessels wider. It can lower blood pressure or improve blood flow and is used for selected heart, blood-pressure, or circulation problems; excessive widening may cause headache, flushing, dizziness, or fainting.

Vasodilators

Alternate name; see *Vasodilator*.

Vasodilatory Shock

Shock caused by widespread widening of blood vessels and loss of vascular tone, leading to dangerously low blood pressure and inadequate blood flow to organs. It can occur in severe infection, anaphylaxis, or some neurologic injuries.

Vasomotor

Relating to control of blood-vessel width by nerves, hormones, and local chemicals. Vasomotor changes narrow or widen vessels and help regulate blood pressure, body temperature, tissue blood flow, and skin color.

Vasomotor Center

A group of nerve cells in the lower brain that helps control the widening and narrowing of blood vessels and helps maintain blood pressure.

Vasomotor Centre

Alternate spelling; see *Vasomotor Center*.

Vasomotor Nerves

Autonomic nerves controlling blood-vessel widening and narrowing by changing smooth-muscle activity, helping regulate blood pressure and temperature.

Vasomotor Rhinitis

Common subtype term; see *Nonallergic Rhinitis*.

Vaso-Occlusive Crisis

An episode in sickle cell disease in which sickled red blood cells obstruct small blood vessels, reducing blood flow and causing acute pain and sometimes tissue injury.

Alternate Names:
Sickle Cell Pain Crisis; VOC

Vasopressin

A hormone made in the hypothalamus and released from the posterior pituitary. It increases water reabsorption in the kidneys and can constrict blood vessels.

Alternate Names:
Arginine Vasopressin; AVP

Vasopressin Receptor

A cell sensor that responds to the hormone vasopressin. Different types help the kidneys retain water and help blood vessels narrow, influencing body-fluid balance and blood pressure.

Vasopressin Receptor Antagonists

Medicines that block vasopressin receptors and increase water excretion by the kidneys. Some are used for selected cases of low blood sodium or fluid overload.

Alternate Names:
Vaptans

Vasopressor

A medicine or body signal that raises blood pressure, mainly by narrowing blood vessels and sometimes by strengthening the heartbeat. Vasopressor medicines are used in conditions such as shock; their effects on blood flow vary by agent and dose.

Vasopressors

Alternate name; see *Vasopressor*.

Vasopressors In Anesthesia

Alternate name; see *Vasopressor*.

Vasospasm

Sudden narrowing of a blood vessel caused by contraction of its muscular wall. It can temporarily reduce blood flow and cause chest pain, headache, stroke-like symptoms, or tissue injury, depending on the vessel affected.

Vasovagal Attack

Alternate name; see *Vasovagal Reaction*.

Vasovagal Reaction

A reflex response that can lower heart rate, blood pressure, or both. It may cause fainting (vasovagal syncope) and can be triggered by pain, fear, heat, or prolonged standing.

Vasovagal Syncope

Temporary loss of consciousness caused by a reflex drop in heart rate, blood pressure, or both, reducing blood flow to the brain. It may be triggered by pain, fear, heat, or prolonged standing and is often preceded by nausea, sweating, or lightheadedness.

Alternate Names:
Neurocardiogenic Syncope; Vasovagal Fainting

Vater-Pacini Corpuscles

Encapsulated sensory receptors found in deep skin and other connective tissues. They respond especially to vibration and changes in pressure.

Alternate Names:
Pacinian Corpuscles; Lamellar Corpuscles

VATS

Alternate name; see *Video-Assisted Thoracoscopic Surgery*.

Vaughan Williams Classification

A system that groups medicines used for abnormal heart rhythms according to their main effect on the heart's electrical activity. It helps describe treatment but does not replace patient-specific prescribing.

VCJD

Alternate name; see *Variant CJD*.

VDRL Test

A blood or spinal-fluid test that looks for an immune reaction associated with syphilis. A reactive result needs a more specific confirmatory test and may help monitor response to treatment.

Vector

1. In infection control, a living organism, such as a mosquito or tick, that carries a disease-causing germ to a person or animal. The germ may develop or multiply inside the vector, or be carried without doing so. 2. In genetics, a molecule or modified virus used to carry genetic material into a cell.

Vector-Borne Disease

An infection spread by a living carrier such as a mosquito, tick, flea, or sandfly. Examples include malaria, dengue, Lyme disease, and some forms of viral encephalitis; prevention focuses on avoiding bites and controlling the carrier.

Vector Control

Measures that reduce insects or other animals that spread infection. Examples include removing standing water, using insecticides, treating breeding areas, improving buildings, wearing protective clothing, and using repellents or bed nets.

Vegetarian

Vegetarian describes a diet that avoids meat and may include dairy products, eggs, or both. Nutritional needs can usually be met with varied foods, but iron, vitamin B12, protein, and other nutrients may need attention.

Vegetation

A mass that can form on a heart valve during infective endocarditis. It may contain bacteria, blood-clotting material, and immune cells and can damage the valve or break off and travel to other organs.

Vein

A blood vessel that carries blood toward the heart. Most veins carry oxygen-poor blood, but veins from the lungs and placenta carry oxygen-rich blood. Veins often contain valves that help prevent backward flow.

Vein-Graft Aneurysms

An abnormal widening of a vein used to bypass a blocked heart artery. It may contain a clot, block blood flow, press on nearby structures, or rupture.

Vein of Galen Malformation

A rare birth defect in which abnormal connections let blood flow directly from arteries into an enlarged vein-like space in the brain that forms from a fetal blood vessel. It can strain the heart in newborns; infants and older children may develop an enlarged head, fluid buildup around the brain, seizures, or developmental problems.

Alternate Names:
VGM; Vein of Galen Aneurysmal Malformation

VeIP Regimen

A cancer-treatment combination of vinblastine, ifosfamide, and cisplatin, used mainly for selected germ-cell tumors. Adverse effects include low blood counts and injury to the kidneys, nerves, or bladder.

Velamentous Cord Insertion

An abnormal attachment in which the umbilical blood vessels travel through the membranes before reaching the placenta without the usual protective tissue. The vessels can be compressed or torn, increasing risks of poor fetal growth, bleeding, and vasa previa.

Alternate Names:
Velamentous Insertion of the Umbilical Cord

Velocardiofacial Syndrome

Alternate name; see *DiGeorge Syndrome*.

Velopharyngeal Insufficiency

A structural or functional anatomical failure of the soft palate (velum) and posterior pharyngeal wall to achieve complete closure during speech and deglutition, resulting in hypernasal speech resonance, nasal air emission, and nasal regurgitation of fluids.

Alternate Names:
VPI; Velopharyngeal Incompetence

Vemurafenib

A targeted cancer medicine for tumors with a specific BRAF V600 gene change, including some melanomas. It can cause joint pain, sun sensitivity, abnormal heart rhythm, new skin cancers, or treatment resistance.

Vena Cava

Either of the two largest veins returning blood to the right side of the heart. The superior vena cava drains the upper body, and the inferior vena cava drains the abdomen, pelvis, and legs.

Alternate Names:
Venae Cavae; Superior and Inferior Vena Cava

Vena Cava Filter

A device placed in the inferior vena cava to catch some blood clots traveling from the legs toward the lungs. It does not prevent clots from forming in the legs and is used in selected circumstances, such as when anticoagulants cannot be given.

Alternate Names:
IVC Filter; Inferior Vena Cava Filter

Venepuncture

Inserting a needle into a vein to collect blood or place intravenous access. It may cause brief pain, bruising, bleeding, infection, or fainting, and clean technique reduces complications.

Venereal Disease Research Laboratory Test

Alternate name; see *VDRL Test*.

Venereology

The medical specialty concerned with sexually transmitted infections and their effects. In many health systems, this work is part of sexual-health medicine, dermatology, or infectious-disease practice.

Venesection

The controlled removal of blood from a vein, used diagnostically or therapeutically, for example in selected cases of hemochromatosis or polycythemia.

Venipuncture

Puncture of a vein with a needle to obtain blood, administer fluids or medicines, or establish intravenous access. Complications include bruising, infection, bleeding, and, rarely, nerve or artery injury.

Venogram

Contrast imaging of veins used to detect thrombosis, obstruction, abnormal anatomy, or selected venous flow disorders.

Venography

Imaging of veins, usually after contrast material is administered, to assess venous anatomy, obstruction, thrombosis, or malformation.

Venom

A poisonous substance delivered by an animal through a bite, sting, or similar structure. Its effects vary by species and may include pain, swelling, nerve problems, bleeding, or dangerous changes in breathing or blood pressure.

Venomous Bite

A bite that injects venom from an animal such as a snake, spider, or arthropod. Effects range from local pain and swelling to bleeding, paralysis, or systemic toxicity.

Veno-Occlusive Disease

Alternate name; see *Hepatic Sinusoidal Obstruction Syndrome*.

Venous

Relating to veins, which usually carry blood back toward the heart. Vein problems include blood clots, varicose veins, poor return of blood, and ulcers; pulmonary veins are an exception because they carry oxygen-rich blood from the lungs to the heart.

Venous Air Embolism

Obstruction of the venous circulation by intravascular gas, usually after procedures, trauma, or pressure changes. It can impair pulmonary or cardiac function and, if gas reaches the arterial circulation, cause neurologic or systemic ischemia.

Venous Aneurysm

A localized abnormal dilatation of a vein. It may be asymptomatic or present as a soft mass, pain, thrombosis, embolism, or bleeding depending on its location and size.

Venous Blood Gas

A test measuring acidity, carbon dioxide, and bicarbonate in blood taken from a vein. It helps assess acid-base balance and carbon dioxide levels, but does not measure oxygenation as reliably as an arterial blood gas.

Alternate Names:
VBG

Venous Capacitance

The ability of veins to expand and hold changing amounts of blood with relatively small changes in pressure. The systemic veins serve as the body's main blood reservoir.

Venous Diseases

Conditions affecting veins, including blood clots, varicose veins, poor return of blood, inflammation, ulcers, injuries, and birth-related malformations. They may cause pain, swelling, skin changes, bleeding, or dangerous clots traveling to the lungs.

Venous Hum

A harmless continuous humming sound heard over the neck veins, most often in healthy children. It changes or disappears with body position or gentle pressure on the vein, helping distinguish it from heart murmurs that need further evaluation.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Venous Hum; Innocent Venous Hum

Venous Insufficiency

Impaired return of blood through the veins, usually in the legs, because valves allow backward flow, veins are blocked, or the calf-muscle pump is ineffective. Blood may pool and cause aching, heaviness, swelling, varicose veins, itching, darkened or hardened skin, stasis dermatitis, and difficult-to-heal ulcers near the ankle.

Venous Leak

A term for difficulty maintaining an erection attributed to excessive blood outflow from the penis. The proposed mechanism is one possible cause of erectile dysfunction and is not established by symptoms alone.

Alternate Names:
Veno-Occlusive Dysfunction; Cavernous Venous Leakage

Venous Pressure

The pressure of blood inside the veins. It depends on blood volume, vein width, gravity, and how well the right side of the heart pumps; abnormally high pressure can cause swelling, enlarged veins, or fluid buildup.

Venous Return

The flow of blood through the veins back to the heart. It is helped by vein valves, muscle movement, breathing, and pressure changes in the chest.

Venous Stasis Dermatitis

Inflammation of the skin of the lower legs caused by chronic swelling and pooling of blood and fluid, usually from chronic venous insufficiency. It may cause itching, redness, scaling, skin darkening, thickening, or ulcers; treatment addresses the swelling and protects the skin.

Venous Stasis Ulcer

Alternate name; see *Venous Ulcer*.

Venous Thromboembolism

A medical condition that encompasses the formation of abnormal blood clots within the deep veins of the body. It most commonly starts as a deep vein thrombosis (DVT), where a blood clot develops in the deep veins of the leg, thigh, or pelvis, causing swelling, warmth, and pain. If a portion of this clot breaks loose and travels through the bloodstream to the lungs, it causes a pulmonary embolism (PE), a life-threatening emergency that blocks blood flow to lung tissue.

Alternate Names:
VTE; Deep Vein Thrombosis and Pulmonary Embolism

Venous Thromboembolism In Pregnancy

A blood clot in a deep vein or lungs during pregnancy or after birth. Pregnancy increases clot risk, and symptoms such as one-sided leg swelling, chest pain, sudden breathlessness, or coughing blood can indicate a serious clot.

Venous Thromboembolism Prophylaxis

Measures used to prevent dangerous vein clots, especially around surgery or hospitalization. They may include walking early, compression devices or stockings, and blood-thinning medicine when bleeding risk is acceptable.

Venous Thrombosis

The formation of a blood clot (thrombus) within a vein, most commonly in the deep veins of the lower extremities (deep vein thrombosis, DVT).

Venous Ulcer

A slow-healing sore caused by poor blood return through the leg veins, usually near the ankle. It may occur with leg swelling, varicose veins, or skin discoloration. Arterial circulation affects the safety of compression therapy.

Ventilation

Movement of air into and out of the lungs. Alveolar ventilation removes carbon dioxide; oxygen uptake into blood is called oxygenation.

Ventilation-Perfusion Mismatch

A mismatch between air reaching parts of the lungs and blood reaching those same parts. It can lower blood oxygen and occur with pneumonia, COPD, asthma, heart failure, or a lung clot.

Ventilation-Perfusion Ratio

The relationship between air reaching the lungs and blood reaching the lung tissues. Good matching allows efficient oxygen exchange; poor matching can cause low blood oxygen.

Ventilation-Perfusion Scan

A nuclear-medicine scan that compares air movement in the lungs with blood flow through them. Areas with blood flow blocked but preserved air movement may suggest a pulmonary embolism. The test uses a breathed tracer and an injected tracer and is interpreted with symptoms and other findings.

Ventilator

A machine that supports or replaces spontaneous breathing by delivering air, oxygen, or an air-oxygen mixture under positive pressure. Noninvasive ventilators deliver support through a mask, while invasive ventilators connect through an endotracheal or tracheostomy tube. Ventilators can provide different patterns and levels of pressure or volume according to the device and clinical purpose.

Alternate Names:
Mechanical Ventilator Breathing Machine

Ventilator-Associated Pneumonia

Pneumonia that develops at least 48 hours after a person begins invasive mechanical ventilation. It may cause fever, worsening oxygen levels, increased airway secretions, or new lung changes on imaging.

Ventilator-Induced Lung Injury

Lung damage caused or worsened by mechanical ventilation, often through excessive stretch, pressure, or repeated opening and closing of lung units.

Ventouse

A vacuum extractor placed on the baby's scalp to assist a vaginal birth when delivery needs help. It is used only when specific safety conditions are met and can cause temporary scalp swelling or bruising.

Ventral

Relating to the belly or front side of the body; synonym for anterior in human anatomy.

Ventral Body Cavity

The body cavity toward the front. It includes the thoracic cavity and the abdominopelvic cavity, which contain many of the body's major organs.

Ventral Hernia

Protrusion of tissue through a weakness in the front abdominal wall, including incisional and umbilical hernias. It may cause a bulge or pain; a trapped hernia can lose its blood supply.

Ventral Root

The front root of a spinal nerve. It carries movement and other outgoing signals from the spinal cord.

Ventricle

One of the two lower chambers of the heart that pump blood out of it. The right ventricle sends blood to the lungs to receive oxygen; the left ventricle sends oxygen-rich blood to the rest of the body.

Ventricular

Relating to a ventricle. In the heart, it concerns one of the lower pumping chambers; in the brain, it concerns the fluid-filled spaces that contain cerebrospinal fluid. The organ gives the term its specific meaning.

Ventricular Aneurysm

A weakened, scarred area of a heart ventricle that bulges outward, most often after a heart attack. It can impair pumping and increase the risk of heart failure, abnormal rhythms, or a clot inside the heart.

Ventricular Arrhythmia

An abnormal heart rhythm arising from the ventricles. It may cause palpitations, dizziness, fainting, chest discomfort, or sudden cardiac arrest.

Ventricular Arrhythmias

Alternate name; see *Ventricular Arrhythmia*.

Ventricular Assist Device

A mechanical pump that helps a weakened heart move blood. It may support the left side, right side, or both and can be temporary or long-term, but bleeding, infection, stroke, and clots are important risks.

Ventricular Bigeminy

A heart-rhythm pattern in which each normal beat is followed by a premature beat from a ventricle. It may be seen on an electrocardiogram and can occur with or without heart disease.

Ventricular Fibrillation

A chaotic, disorganized, and life-threatening heart rhythm in which the lower heart chambers (the ventricles) quiver erratically instead of pumping blood. Because the heart cannot pump blood to the brain and vital organs, the pulse instantly disappears, causing sudden collapse, loss of consciousness within seconds, and cardiac arrest. It is a critical medical emergency requiring immediate cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) and electric defibrillation to restore a normal heartbeat.

Alternate Names:
V-Fib; VF

Ventricular Hypertrophy

Thickening of the wall of one of the heart's lower chambers. It may develop from long-term high blood pressure, valve disease, inherited heart muscle disease, or intense training and can lead to stiffness, abnormal rhythms, or heart failure.

Ventricular Myocardium

The heart muscle forming the walls of the ventricles. Its contraction pumps blood to the lungs and the rest of the body.

Ventricular Non-Compaction

An imaging phenotype with prominent left-ventricular trabeculations and deep recesses. It may occur with cardiomyopathy or as an isolated finding, so the appearance alone does not establish heart disease. *Left ventricular hypertrabeculation* is the preferred descriptive term; "non-compaction cardiomyopathy" is an older label.

Alternate Names:
LVNC; Left Ventricular Hypertrabeculation

Ventricular Premature Contraction

Alternate name; see *Premature Ventricular Contraction*.

Ventricular Remodeling

Changes in the size, shape, or muscle of a heart ventricle after injury or long-term strain. These changes can affect how well the heart fills and pumps.

Alternate Names:
Post-Infarction Remodeling

Ventricular Rupture

A tear in a wall of one of the heart's lower chambers, often after a heart attack. It can cause life-threatening bleeding around the heart.

Ventricular Septal Defect

An opening in the wall between the heart's lower chambers, usually present from birth. Blood often flows from the left ventricle to the right, increasing blood flow to the lungs. Small defects may close spontaneously; a large shunt can cause heart failure and, over time, pulmonary vascular disease.

Ventricular Septal Defect (VSD)

Alternate name; see *Ventricular Septal Defect*.

Alternate Names:
VSD

Ventricular Tachycardia

A rapid, abnormal heart rhythm originating from the heart's lower pumping chambers (the ventricles) rather than the natural pacemaker in the upper chambers. Beating at an abnormally fast rate (typically over 100 beats per minute), the ventricles do not have enough time between beats to fill properly with blood, drastically reducing the amount of blood pumped throughout the body. It can cause palpitations, lightheadedness, chest pain, and fainting, and can progress into a life-threatening cardiac arrest.

Alternate Names:
VT; V-Tach

Ventriculoatrial

Relating to a connection between a ventricle and an atrium. In brain surgery, a ventriculoatrial shunt is a tube that drains extra fluid from a brain cavity into the right upper chamber of the heart.

Ventriculoatrial Shunt

A surgically implanted cerebrospinal-fluid diversion system that drains fluid from a brain ventricle through a valve and catheter tunneled under the skin into a vein, with the distal catheter positioned in the right atrium. It treats hydrocephalus by returning excess fluid to the bloodstream and may be used when peritoneal drainage is unsuitable. Potential complications include blockage or infection and, because the catheter lies in the venous circulation, thrombosis or embolism.

Alternate Names:
VA Shunt; Ventriculo-Atrial Shunt

Ventriculography

Imaging of a heart ventricle, usually during cardiac catheterization after contrast dye is injected into the chamber. It shows chamber shape and movement

and can help assess pumping function.

Ventriculoperitoneal Shunt

A surgically implanted catheter-and-valve system that diverts cerebrospinal fluid from a brain ventricle through tubing tunneled beneath the skin into the peritoneal cavity, where the fluid is absorbed. It is commonly used to treat hydrocephalus by reducing excess fluid and pressure in the ventricles. The valve regulates flow and may be fixed-pressure or programmable. Complications include blockage, infection, overdrainage or underdrainage, and problems at the abdominal catheter tip; malfunction can allow fluid to build up again or drain too rapidly.

Alternate Names:
VP Shunt

Ventriculoperitoneal Shunt Placement

The surgical implantation of a flexible drainage catheter and one-way valve connecting the cerebral ventricles to the peritoneal cavity to relieve hydrocephalus; see *Ventriculoperitoneal Shunt*.

Ventrosuspension

Surgical fixation of a displaced or prolapsed uterus to the anterior abdominal wall or nearby supporting tissues.

Venturi Mask

An oxygen mask that mixes oxygen with room air through calibrated openings to deliver a controlled oxygen concentration.

Alternate Names:
Air-Entrainment Mask; Venturi Oxygen Mask

Venturi Principle

The principle that a fluid's speed increases and its pressure decreases as it passes through a narrowed section of a tube. In medicine, this effect helps draw air into some oxygen masks and fluids into some suction devices.

Alternate Names:
Venturi Effect; Bernoulli-Venturi Principle; Air-Entrainment Principle

Venule

A small blood vessel that collects blood from capillaries and carries it into larger veins. Venules also allow white blood cells and fluid to leave the bloodstream during inflammation.

Venules

Alternate name; see *Venule*.

Verapamil

A non-dihydropyridine calcium-channel blocker used for selected hypertension, angina, and supraventricular tachyarrhythmias; it can cause bradycardia and constipation.

Verapamil Toxicity

Harm from an overdose or excessive exposure to verapamil, which can cause low blood pressure, a slow heart rate, abnormal heart rhythms, and impaired heart pumping.

Vermicides

Medicines or chemicals that kill parasitic worms. The correct treatment depends on the worm, the body site affected, the person's age, and other health conditions.

Vernal Keratoconjunctivitis

A recurrent allergic inflammation of the conjunctiva, usually beginning in childhood. It causes intense itching, tearing, light sensitivity, and stringy mucus; severe disease can involve the cornea and impair vision.

Alternate Names:
VKC; Spring Catarrh; Vernal Catarrh; Vernal Conjunctivitis

Verner-Morrison Syndrome

Alternate name; see *VIPoma*.

Vernix

A white, greasy protective coating on the skin of a fetus or newborn, composed mainly of water, lipids, and shed skin cells.

Vernix Caseosa

Alternate name; see *Vernix*.

Verruca

A common, non-cancerous skin growth (wart) caused by localized infection of the top layer of skin with human papillomavirus (HPV). The virus causes rapid multiplication of skin cells, creating a rough, raised bump that may develop tiny dark dots (thrombosed capillaries). Warts can develop on any area of the skin, commonly appearing on the hands and fingers (common warts) or on the soles of the feet (plantar warts), where pressure from walking can make them painful.

Alternate Names:
Verrucas; Verrucae; Wart; Warts

Verruca Plana

Small, smooth, relatively flat warts caused by HPV, often occurring in groups on the face, hands, or legs.

Alternate Names:
Flat Warts; Juvenile Warts

Verrucas

Plural form; see *Verruca*.

Verruca Vulgaris

A common, benign skin wart caused by human papillomavirus. It is a raised growth with a rough surface and may have tiny dark dots from clotted capillaries.

Alternate Names:
Common Wart; Viral Verruca

Verruciform Xanthoma

A rare, noncancerous growth usually found in the mouth or genital area. It may look like a wart, so examination and sometimes a tissue sample are needed to distinguish it from cancer.

Verrucose

Alternate spelling; see *Verrucous*.

Verrucous

Having a rough, thickened, irregular, or wart-like surface. The appearance can occur in benign growths, infections, chronic inflammation, or some cancers.

Verrucous Carcinoma

A low-grade, well-differentiated variant of squamous cell carcinoma with a warty, exophytic appearance. It is locally invasive but rarely metastasizes, commonly affecting the oral cavity, skin, or genitalia.

Verrucous Secondary Syphilis

A rare wart-like form of secondary syphilis with thickened, papillomatous skin or mucosal lesions, often in moist or anogenital areas. It is caused by systemic infection with *Treponema pallidum* and may resemble genital warts or other verrucous growths.

Version

A change in the position or presentation of a body structure. In pregnancy, fetal version is a procedure or movement that changes the baby's position, often to place the head downward before birth.

Vertebra

One of the bones forming the spinal column. Each vertebra helps support the body, allows movement, provides attachment for muscles, and surrounds and protects the spinal cord.

Vertebrae

Vertebrae are the bones of the spinal column that protect the spinal cord, support the body, allow movement, and provide attachment for muscles and ligaments.

Vertebral Artery

One of two arteries that travel through the neck and join to supply the brainstem, cerebellum, and back of the brain. Narrowing or blockage can cause dizziness, imbalance, or stroke.

Vertebral Artery Dissection

A tear in the inner lining of a vertebral artery that lets blood enter the vessel wall, forming an intramural hematoma and possibly narrowing the artery or

creating a pseudoaneurysm. It may occur spontaneously or after neck injury and can cause sudden neck or occipital headache, dizziness, imbalance, or a posterior-circulation transient ischemic attack or stroke.

Alternate Names:
VAD; Spontaneous Vertebral Artery Dissection

Vertebral Canal

The passage formed by the stacked spinal bones that surrounds and protects the spinal cord. Narrowing, bleeding, tumors, fractures, or disc disease inside it can compress nerves and cause weakness or pain.

Vertebral Column

The chain of bones running from the neck to the pelvis. It supports the head and trunk, protects the spinal cord, allows bending and twisting, and provides attachment for muscles and ribs.

Vertebral Compression Fracture

Collapse or cracking of one of the bones in the spine, often from osteoporosis, injury, or cancer. It may cause sudden or gradual back pain, loss of height, or a rounded back and can sometimes press on nerves.

Vertebral Hemangioma

A common, benign, primary vascular malformation of the vertebral body characterized histopathologically by a proliferation of thin-walled, blood-filled capillary and cavernous vessels interspersed within the bony trabeculae of the spine. Most frequently situated in the thoracic and lumbar spine, the vast majority are asymptomatic and discovered incidentally on spine imaging, displaying a characteristic vertical striation ("corduroy cloth" or "jail bar" pattern) on lateral plain radiographs and a classic "polka-dot" appearance on axial CT. Rare aggressive or expanding hemangiomas can cause cortical erosion, pathologic compression fracture, or extraosseous epidural expansion resulting in spinal cord compression or radiculopathy; treatment for symptomatic lesions includes endovascular embolization, percutaneous vertebroplasty, or surgical decompression.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Hemangioma

Vertebral Osteomyelitis

An infection of one or more bones in the spine, usually caused by bacteria that reach the bone through the blood or during a procedure. It can cause persistent, localized back pain and may spread to nearby discs or tissues. See also *Discitis*.

Vertebral Tumor

A growth arising in or near a spinal bone. It may be benign or cancerous, start in the spine or spread there, and cause pain, fracture, nerve compression, weakness, or paralysis.

Vertebrobasilar Circulatory Disorders

Conditions that reduce blood flow through the vertebral or basilar arteries supplying the brainstem, cerebellum, and posterior brain; symptoms may include vertigo, double vision, imbalance, weakness, or stroke.

Vertebrobasilar Insufficiency

Reduced blood flow through arteries supplying the back of the brain. It may cause dizziness, double vision, imbalance, weakness, trouble speaking, or stroke-like symptoms and can be serious when sudden.

Vertebrobasilar Insuffiency

Misspelling; see *Vertebrobasilar Insufficiency*.

Vertebroplasty

A procedure in which medical cement is injected into a collapsed spinal bone to help stabilize it and sometimes reduce pain. It is used selectively because cement leakage, infection, nerve injury, or other complications can occur.

Vertical

Oriented from superior to inferior or perpendicular to a horizontal plane. In medicine, it may describe position, transmission from parent to child, or a body-oriented imaging or movement axis.

Vertical Talus

A stiff flatfoot present from birth in which one of the ankle bones points downward and the middle of the foot is bent upward. It may occur alone or with other conditions and can impair standing and walking.

Vertical Transmission

Passage of an infection or genetic condition from parent to child during pregnancy, delivery, or breastfeeding.

Vertigo

A false feeling that you or your surroundings are moving, spinning, tilting, or shifting when they are not. It is a symptom rather than a disease and often comes from the inner ear, but brain and other conditions can also cause it.

Vertigo-Associated Disorders

Vertigo-associated disorders cause an illusion of movement from vestibular, neurologic, visual, medication-related, or systemic dysfunction and may be accompanied by imbalance, nausea, or hearing symptoms.

Alternate Names:
Vestibular Disorders; Peripheral Vestibulopathy; Labyrinthine Disorders

Very Long-Chain Acyl-CoA Dehydrogenase Deficiency

A rare inherited disorder in which cells cannot use certain long-chain fats for energy, especially during fasting or illness. Infants may develop low blood sugar, heart disease, or liver problems; older children or adults may have exercise-triggered muscle breakdown and dark urine.

Alternate Names:
VLCAD Deficiency; VLCADD

Very-Low-Density Lipoprotein

A particle made by the liver that carries mainly triglycerides through the blood. High levels can contribute to fatty deposits in artery walls and increase cardiovascular risk, although the result is interpreted with the full lipid profile.

Alternate Names:
VLDL

Vesical

Relating to the urinary bladder. For example, vesical inflammation affects the bladder lining, a vesical tumor is a bladder growth, and the vesical neck is the bladder outlet leading toward the urethra.

Vesicant

A substance that causes blistering and tissue injury on contact. In oncology, vesicant drugs can cause severe extravasation injury if they escape from a vein into surrounding tissue.

Vesicants

Alternate name; see *Vesicant*.

Vesicle

A small, circumscribed, raised skin lesion containing clear, serous, or sometimes bloody fluid, usually less than 1 cm in diameter. A vesicle is a small blister; causes include viral infection, contact irritation, eczema, burns, friction, and immune-mediated skin disease.

Vesicoureteral Reflux

Backward flow of urine from the bladder toward the kidneys because the valve where a ureter enters the bladder does not work normally. It can cause repeated kidney infections and scarring, especially in children.

Alternate Names:
VUR; Urinary Reflux

Vesico-Ureteric Reflux

Backward flow of urine from the bladder into one or both ureters and sometimes the kidneys, increasing the risk of recurrent urinary infection and renal scarring.

Vesicovaginal and Ureterovaginal Fistula

Abnormal connections between the urinary tract and vagina: a vesicovaginal fistula connects bladder to vagina, while a ureterovaginal fistula connects

ureter to vagina. Both commonly cause continuous urine leakage and require imaging and reconstructive urologic or gynecologic care.

Vesicovaginal Fistula

An abnormal connection between the bladder and vagina that causes continuous or frequent leakage of urine through the vagina. It may follow childbirth injury, pelvic surgery, radiation, or advanced infection and usually requires specialist repair.

Vesicular

Describing or containing small, fluid-filled blisters. A vesicular rash may occur with viral infection, allergy, eczema, burns, or other conditions; its appearance alone does not establish the cause.

Vesicular Breathing

The normal soft, gentle breath sound heard over most outer lung areas with a stethoscope. Changes in loudness or quality may suggest fluid, collapse, blockage, infection, or other lung disease.

Vesicular Palmoplantar Eczema

An itchy eczema affecting the palms or soles with small, deep-seated fluid-filled vesicles, followed by peeling, scaling, or fissures. Triggers include sweating, irritants, allergy, stress, and fungal infection elsewhere; persistent disease may need specialist treatment.

Vesiculobullous Dermatoses

A group of skin diseases that cause small or large fluid-filled blisters. Causes include infection, allergy, autoimmune disease, inherited conditions, medicines, and injury; examination and sometimes a biopsy identify the cause.

Vessel

A vessel is a tube carrying blood, lymph, air, urine, bile, or another fluid through the body, depending on context.

Vestibular

Relating to the vestibular system of the inner ear and brain, which detects head motion and position and helps maintain balance and gaze stability.

Vestibular Disorder

A problem affecting the inner-ear balance organs or the brain pathways that process balance signals. It may cause dizziness, vertigo, unsteadiness, nausea, abnormal eye movements, or difficulty walking. Causes include inner-ear disease, infection, head injury, medicines, migraine, reduced blood flow, or disorders of the brain or nerves.

Alternate Names:
Vestibular Balance Disorder

Vestibular Migraine

Repeated attacks of dizziness or vertigo related to migraine, with or without headache. Episodes may include sensitivity to movement, light, sound, or visual patterns; symptoms overlap with other inner-ear and neurologic disorders.

Vestibular Neuritis

A sudden problem affecting the nerve that carries balance signals from the inner ear to the brain. It can cause severe spinning dizziness, nausea, and unsteadiness for days. Hearing is usually not affected.

Vestibular Papillomatosis

A harmless normal variation in which several soft, small, finger-like bumps occur on the inner vulvar folds. It can resemble genital warts but is not caused by an infection.

Vestibular Rehabilitation

Exercise-based therapy that improves balance, gaze stability, and adaptation in people with vestibular disorders or dizziness.

Vestibular Schwannoma

A usually noncancerous, slow-growing growth on the nerve that carries balance signals from the inner ear to the brain. It may cause hearing loss in one ear, ringing, or unsteadiness. Also called an acoustic neuroma.

Vestibular System

The inner-ear sensors and connected brain pathways that detect head movement and position and help maintain balance, posture, and steady vision. Problems can cause vertigo, unsteadiness, nausea, or blurred vision during movement.

Vestibule

A balance area of the inner ear between the cochlea and semicircular canals. It contains sensors that detect head position and straight-line movement and send this information to the brain.

Vestibulocochlear Nerve

The eighth cranial nerve, carrying information for hearing and balance from the inner ear to the brain.

Vestibulodynia

Pain localized to the vulvar vestibule, the area around the vaginal opening. It is often triggered by touch or penetration and is commonly described as localized, provoked vulvodynia.

Alternate Names:
Provoked Vestibulodynia; Vulvar Vestibulitis Syndrome; PVD

Vestibulo-Ocular Reflex

An automatic response that moves the eyes opposite to head movement so vision stays steady while a person turns or walks. Problems with it can cause blurred vision, dizziness, or imbalance.

Vestigial

Describing a structure or feature that has become greatly reduced through evolution and has little or no apparent original function.

VEXAS Syndrome

A serious inflammatory illness that begins in adulthood because of a gene change acquired in blood-forming cells. It can cause persistent fever, painful joints, skin rashes, inflamed blood vessels or cartilage, anemia, and other blood abnormalities.

V-Fib

Alternate name; see *Ventricular Fibrillation*.

Viable

Capable of surviving or developing under suitable conditions. In clinical contexts it may describe a viable pregnancy, tissue, organism, cell, or treatment option.

Vibration Problem

Symptoms or injury caused by repeated exposure to vibrating tools or equipment, which may affect nerves, blood vessels, muscles, and joints in the hands or arms.

Vibrator

A device that produces mechanical vibration and may be used for sexual stimulation, therapeutic massage, or selected rehabilitation purposes.

Vibrio

A genus of motile, facultatively anaerobic, comma-shaped (curved) gram-negative bacilli that naturally inhabit marine, estuarine, and coastal aquatic environments. Notable human pathogenic species include *Vibrio cholerae* (serogroups O1 and O139 producing cholera toxin, a potent ADP-ribosylating enterotoxin that causes massive secretory diarrhea, profound dehydration, and rapid hypovolemic shock in cholera), *Vibrio vulnificus* (acquired via raw seafood consumption or wound exposure to seawater, causing fulminant septicemia and life-threatening necrotizing fasciitis), and *Vibrio parahaemolyticus* (a leading cause of self-limited acute seafood-associated gastroenteritis).

Alternate Names:
Vibrios

Vibrio Cholerae

A bacterium that causes cholera, a severe diarrheal illness spread mainly through contaminated water or food. It can cause sudden, large-volume watery diarrhea, dehydration, shock, and death without rapid fluid replacement.

Vibrio Infection

Illness caused by pathogenic *Vibrio* bacteria, usually acquired by eating raw or undercooked seafood or when a wound contacts coastal or brackish water. It commonly causes watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, or vomiting; some species cause wound infection or bloodstream infection, which can be severe, particularly in people with liver disease. Cholera caused by toxigenic *V. cholerae* O1 or O139 is classified separately.

Alternate Names:
Vibriosis

Vibrio Parahaemolyticus Infection

A foodborne intestinal infection caused by a salt-tolerant bacterium, often linked to raw or undercooked seafood. It commonly causes watery diarrhea, abdominal cramps, nausea, vomiting, and sometimes fever.

Alternate Names:
Vibrio Parahaemolyticus Gastroenteritis; Halophilic Vibrio Infection

Vibrios

Plural form; see *Vibrio*.

Vibrio vulnificus Infection

Infection caused by a saltwater-associated bacterium that can produce rapidly progressive wound infection, sepsis, or severe gastroenteritis. Risk is higher with liver disease, iron overload, or immune suppression; raw oysters and seawater exposure are important sources.

Vibrio Vulnificus Infections

Alternate name; see *Vibrio vulnificus Infection*.

Video-Assisted Thoracoscopic Surgery

Surgery inside the chest performed through small incisions using a camera and long instruments. It is used for procedures such as lung or pleural biopsy and lung resection; complications can include bleeding, air leakage, or infection.

Alternate Names:
VATS; Video Thoracoscopy; Thoracoscopic Surgery

Videofluoroscopic Swallow Study

A moving X-ray test that records swallowing after small amounts of food or liquid containing contrast are taken. It shows whether food enters the airway, where swallowing is delayed, and which textures or techniques may be safer.

Video Laryngoscope

An airway device with a small camera that shows the entrance to the windpipe on a screen. It helps clinicians place a breathing tube, especially when a direct view is difficult, but does not remove the risks of the procedure.

Video Laryngoscopy

A technique for viewing the entrance to the windpipe with a camera on a blade connected to a screen. It can help clinicians place a breathing tube when a direct view is difficult.

Videostroboscopy

A voice examination that uses a camera and flashing light to create a slow-motion view of the vocal cords as they vibrate. It helps investigate hoarseness, voice strain, and vocal-cord injury.

Vildagliptin

An oral dipeptidyl-peptidase-4 inhibitor used in some countries for type 2 diabetes, alone or with other medicines. It improves glucose-dependent insulin secretion; uncommon adverse effects include liver injury and pancreatitis.

Villi

Tiny finger-like projections lining the small intestine that greatly increase the area available to absorb nutrients. Similar projections in the placenta help exchange substances between the pregnant person and fetus.

Villous Adenoma

A type of precancerous polyp in the large intestine with finger-like projections. Villous features, especially in a large polyp or one with high-grade dysplasia, are associated with increased risk of colorectal cancer.

Alternate Names:
Villous Colonic Polyp; Papillary Adenoma

Villous Atrophy

Flattening or loss of the tiny projections lining the small intestine. This reduces nutrient absorption and may occur in celiac disease, some infections, immune disorders, or other intestinal conditions.

Villus

A small finger-like projection, especially one of the intestinal mucosa that increases absorptive surface area; chorionic villi mediate exchange between placenta and fetus.

Villus Atrophy

Alternate name; see *Villous Atrophy*.

Vinca Alkaloids

Cancer medicines including vincristine and vinblastine that disrupt microtubules, structures needed for cell division. They can treat several cancers but may cause nerve damage, low blood counts, constipation, or other toxicity.

Vincent Angina

Alternate name; see *Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis*.

Vincent Disease

Alternate name; see *Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis*.

Vincent Infection

Alternate name; see *Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis*.

Vincent's Angina

Alternate name; see *Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis*.

Vincent Stomatitis

Alternate name; see *Acute Necrotizing Ulcerative Gingivitis*.

Vinorelbine

A chemotherapy medicine that interferes with cell division. It is used for selected lung and breast cancers and can cause low blood counts, infection, constipation, nerve symptoms, nausea, or irritation if it leaks outside a vein.

Viomycin

An older aminoglycoside antibiotic related to capreomycin that was used against tuberculosis and other mycobacterial infections; kidney and hearing toxicity limit its use.

VIPoma

A rare neuroendocrine tumor, usually in the pancreas, that produces excess vasoactive intestinal peptide (VIP). It causes persistent watery diarrhea and can lead to low potassium and dehydration.

Alternate Names:
Vasoactive Intestinal Peptide Tumor; Verner-Morrison Neoplasm; WDHA Syndrome; Pancreatic Cholera

VIPoma Syndrome

Alternate name; see *VIPoma*.

Viraemia

Alternate spelling; see *Viremia*.

Viral

Caused by or relating to a virus. Viruses enter living cells to multiply and can cause illnesses ranging from mild colds to serious brain, lung, liver, or bleeding diseases; testing and treatment depend on the specific virus.

Viral Antibody

An immune protein that recognizes a virus. A test for viral antibodies may show past infection, vaccination, or an immune response; its meaning depends on the virus, test, and timing.

Viral Arthritis

Joint inflammation caused by or associated with a viral infection. It may cause sudden pain, swelling,

and stiffness in several joints and often improves as the infection resolves, although some viruses can cause prolonged symptoms.

Viral Assembly

The stage of viral reproduction when newly made viral genetic material and proteins are put together to form complete new virus particles.

Viral Attachment

The first step of infection, when proteins on a virus bind to matching molecules on a host cell. This binding helps determine which species, tissues, or cell types the virus can infect.

Viral Carcinogenesis

Cancer development caused or promoted by a viral infection. Some viruses alter cell growth directly, weaken immune protection, or cause long-lasting inflammation; examples include human papillomavirus, hepatitis B and C viruses, and Epstein-Barr virus.

Viral Conjunctivitis

Inflammation of the conjunctiva caused by a virus, often producing red, watery, irritated eyes and sometimes discharge. It is usually contagious and can spread through contact with infected secretions or contaminated hands and surfaces.

Viral Culture

Growth of a virus in susceptible cell cultures to identify an infectious agent. It can be useful for selected viruses, but molecular and antigen-based tests are often faster or more sensitive; the appropriate method depends on the suspected infection and specimen.

Viral Encephalitis

Inflammation of the brain caused by a virus. It may cause fever, headache, confusion, behavior change, seizures, weakness, or reduced consciousness. Severe cases can be life-threatening.

Viral Entry

The process by which a virus gets inside a host cell and releases its genetic material so the cell can make more virus.

Viral Exanthem

A widespread rash caused by a viral infection. It may occur with fever, tiredness, sore throat, cough, diarrhea, or other symptoms; the rash pattern and overall illness help determine the cause.

Viral Gastroenteritis

Infection of the stomach and intestines by a virus, usually causing diarrhea, vomiting, or both. “Stomach flu” is a colloquial term and does not mean influenza.

Viral Haemorrhagic Fever

Alternate spelling; see *Viral Hemorrhagic Fevers*.

Viral Hemorrhagic Fevers

A group of illnesses caused by several virus families that can affect multiple organs and disrupt blood-vessel function and clotting. Some cause bleeding, shock, or organ failure; routes of spread and transmission risk vary by virus.

Alternate Names:
VHF; Viral Hemorrhagic Disease

Viral Hepatitis

Liver inflammation caused by hepatitis viruses A, B, C, D, or E. The viruses differ in how they spread and whether they can cause long-term infection; hepatitis D occurs only in people with hepatitis B.

Alternate Names:

Viral Hepatitis Types

The five main hepatitis viruses—A, B, C, D, and E. They differ in how they spread, whether infection can become long-term, and the liver complications they can cause.

Viral Immune Evasion

Ways viruses avoid or weaken the body’s immune

defenses, allowing them to survive, multiply, or return after infection. These methods can make infections harder to clear and vaccines or treatments less effective.

Viral Infection

An illness caused by a virus entering body cells and making copies of itself. Viruses can damage cells directly or cause inflammation as the immune system responds. Viral infections range from mild illnesses such as colds and cold sores to serious diseases such as influenza, COVID-19, hepatitis, and HIV. Some viruses remain inactive in the body and can become active again later, such as the chickenpox virus causing shingles.

Alternate Names:
Viral Infections; Viral Disease; Viral Illness

Viral Infections and Pregnancy

Viral infections during pregnancy may affect maternal illness, fetal development, placenta, or newborn health. Evaluation considers the virus, gestational age, symptoms, immunity, exposure, testing, treatment, vaccination, and measures to reduce perinatal transmission.

Viral Infections of the Mouth

Infections of oral skin or mucosa caused by viruses such as herpes simplex, varicella-zoster, enteroviruses, HPV, or EBV. They may cause blisters, ulcers, warts, sore throat, or systemic symptoms, and treatment depends on the virus and host risk.

Viral Latency

A state in which a virus remains in host cells with limited or no production of new virus particles. Some latent viruses can reactivate; triggers vary by virus and may include weakened immune defenses.

Viral Latency Mechanisms

Alternate name; see *Viral Latency*.

Viral Load

The amount of virus or viral genetic material in a body fluid or tissue, measured by a laboratory assay; trends can help assess disease activity or response to antiviral treatment.

Viral Meningitis

Infection and inflammation of the coverings of the brain and spinal cord caused by a virus. It may cause fever, headache, neck stiffness, vomiting, light sensitivity, or confusion. Bacterial meningitis can cause similar symptoms and is more dangerous.

Viral Myocarditis

Inflammation of the heart muscle caused by a viral infection or by the immune response after an infection. It may cause tiredness, chest discomfort, palpitations, heart failure, shock, or dangerous abnormal heart rhythms.

Viral Pathogenesis

The ways a virus enters the body, infects and spreads through cells, and causes illness. Damage may come directly from infected cells or from the immune system's response to the infection.

Viral Pericarditis

Inflammation of the sac around the heart caused by a viral infection. It often follows a respiratory or stomach illness and may cause sharp chest pain that changes with breathing or position.

Viral Pharyngitis

Inflammation of the throat caused by a virus. It may cause sore throat, cough, runny nose, or conjunctivitis; the specific symptoms vary with the virus.

Alternate Names:
Viral Sore Throat; Acute Viral Pharyngotonsillitis; Viral Upper Respiratory Pharyngitis

Viral Pneumonia

Infection and inflammation of lung tissue caused by a virus, producing cough, fever, chills, breathlessness, chest discomfort, fatigue, and variable impairment of oxygenation. Severe disease can cause respiratory failure or secondary bacterial infection.

Viral Release

The stage when newly made viruses leave an infected cell and spread to other cells. Some leave by pushing through the cell membrane, while others are released when the infected cell breaks apart.

Viral Replication

The process by which a virus uses an infected cell to copy its genetic material and make viral proteins. The exact steps differ among viruses, but the result is production of new virus particles.

Viral Replication Cycle

Alternate name; see *Viral Replication*.

Viral Respiratory Infection

An infection of the nose, throat, or lower respiratory tract caused by a respiratory virus. Symptoms may include cough, runny nose, sore throat, fever, fatigue, or breathing difficulty; the specific virus and severity determine the clinical presentation.

Viral Rhinitis

Inflammation of the nasal lining caused by a respiratory virus, often as part of the common cold. It can cause a runny or blocked nose, sneezing, sore throat, and reduced sense of smell.

Alternate Names:
Acute Viral Rhinitis; Acute Coryza

Viral Structure

The parts of a virus: genetic material made of DNA or RNA inside a protective protein coat. Some viruses also have an outer fatty covering taken from the infected cell's membrane.

Viral Uncoating

The step after a virus enters a cell when its protective outer coat comes apart and releases the genetic material. The cell can then be directed to make new viral components.

Virchow Node

An enlarged lymph node above the left collarbone that may indicate cancer spread from the chest or abdomen through lymphatic drainage. It is classically associated with stomach cancer but can occur with other cancers.

Alternate Names:
Troisier Node

Virchow-Robin Spaces

Small fluid-filled spaces around blood vessels as they pass through the brain. They are a normal part of the spaces that surround and support these vessels.

Alternate Names:
Perivascular Spaces

Virchow's Triad

Alternate name; see *Virchow Triad*.

Virchow Triad

Three factors that increase the chance of a blood clot forming: injury to the inside of a blood vessel, slow blood flow, and blood that clots too easily.

Alternate Names:
Virchow's Triad; Thrombosis Pathophysiological Triad

Viremia

The presence of a virus in the bloodstream. It may be brief or persistent and can allow infection to spread to other organs. Laboratory tests may detect the virus itself or its genetic material.

Viridans Streptococci

Viridans streptococci are a group of bacteria commonly found in the mouth that can cause dental infections and, after entering the blood, infect heart valves.

Virilisation

The development of male secondary sexual characteristics in females, resulting from excessive androgen production or exposure.

Virilism

Development of masculinizing features in a female, usually from excess androgen exposure or production, such as hirsutism, deep voice, acne, and men-

strual disturbance.

Virilism Foetal

Prenatal or neonatal masculinization of a genetically female fetus or infant due to excess androgen exposure. Causes include congenital adrenal hyperplasia, maternal androgen-producing disease, or placental and fetal steroidogenic disorders.

Virilization

Virilization is development of typically male secondary sexual features, such as hirsutism, deep voice, acne, increased muscle mass, or clitoromegaly, from androgen excess or androgen exposure.

Virilize

To virilize is to develop or cause typically male physical changes from androgen excess or treatment, including facial hair, voice deepening, acne, muscle change, or genital enlargement.

Virology

The study of viruses, including their structure, reproduction, spread, effects on the body, diagnosis, treatment, and prevention.

Virotherapy

Treatment that uses a virus, often modified, to attack cancer cells or deliver a useful gene into cells. It is an evolving field; the possible benefits, risks, and availability depend on the specific therapy and disease.

Virtual Colonoscopy

Virtual colonoscopy is CT colonography, which uses bowel preparation and gas or carbon-dioxide insufflation to create images of the colon; it can detect polyps and masses but cannot remove lesions or biopsy them.

Virulence

How severely a microorganism can cause disease or tissue damage. It depends on the organism's harmful properties and on the person's immune defenses and other health factors.

Virulence Factor

A feature of a microorganism that helps it survive in the body, avoid immune defenses, attach to cells, damage tissue, or cause disease. Examples include toxins, protective coatings, and enzymes.

Virulent

Capable of causing severe disease or extensive harm. Virulence describes the harmfulness of a microorganism and is different from infectivity, which describes how easily it spreads or establishes infection.

Virus

An infectious agent made of genetic material inside a protective protein coat, sometimes with an outer membrane. It can reproduce only inside living cells and may cause illness by damaging cells or triggering inflammation.

Virus Activation

Virus activation is the switch from a dormant or inactive viral state to production of new viral components and particles.

Virus Assembly

Alternate name; see *Viral Assembly*.

Virus Diseases

Illnesses caused by viruses. They range from mild infections of one area, such as a cold, to severe diseases affecting the lungs, liver, brain, blood, or several organs; prevention and treatment depend on the virus.

Viruses

Alternate name; see *Virus*.

Virus Integration

Virus integration is insertion of viral genetic material into the DNA of a host cell, a process used by some viruses and important in certain cancers.

Virus Protein

A virus protein is a protein made from viral genetic instructions that helps form the virus, enter cells,

replicate, or evade immunity.

Virus Receptor

A virus receptor is a molecule on a host cell that a virus binds to in order to attach to and enter the cell.

Virus Replication

Alternate name; see *Viral Replication*.

Virus Uncoating

Virus uncoating is removal of the virus's protective outer layer after entry into a host cell, releasing its genetic material for replication.

Viscera

The internal organs of the body, particularly those within the thoracic and abdominal cavities. The thoracic viscera include the heart, lungs, esophagus, trachea, and thymus.

Visceral

Relating to the internal organs, especially those within the thorax or abdomen, rather than the body wall or limbs.

Visceral Afferents

Sensory nerve fibers that carry information from internal organs to the spinal cord and brain. They convey signals related to stretch, chemical changes, inflammation, and internal pain and help regulate autonomic and reflex responses.

Visceral Larva Migrans

A syndrome caused by migration of animal nematode larvae through human tissues, most often from Toxocara species. It may produce fever, eosinophilia, liver lesions, or ocular and neurologic disease.

Visceral Leishmaniasis

A serious parasitic infection caused by Leishmania species and spread by sand flies. It affects internal organs, especially the spleen, liver, and bone marrow, and can cause prolonged fever, weight loss, anemia, and enlargement of the liver and spleen.

Alternate Names:
Kala-Azar; Black Fever; Dumdum Fever; Systemic Leishmaniasis

Visceral Pain

Pain arising from internal organs, often felt as pressure, cramping, aching, or poorly localized discomfort rather than sharp surface pain. It may result from stretching, inflammation, reduced blood flow, obstruction, or injury of an organ.

Viscerogenic

Originating in the internal organs; the term may describe pain or reflexes that arise from them.

Visceromegaly

Abnormal enlargement of one or more internal organs, such as the liver, spleen, or kidneys. It is a physical finding with causes that include infection, congestion, storage disease, inflammation, and cancer.

Viscerotropic

Primarily affecting or tending to target the internal organs (viscera), as a disease or infectious agent.

Viscus

An internal organ, especially one in the chest or abdomen. The plural is viscera; examples include the heart, lungs, liver, stomach, and intestines.

Vision

The sense that detects light and enables the brain to form and interpret images, including shape, color, movement, and spatial relationships. It depends on the eyes, optic nerves, and visual pathways in the brain.

Alternate Names:
Eyesight; Sight; Visual Perception

Vision And Hearing

Two major senses used to understand and communicate with the world. Problems may develop separately or together because of aging, illness, injury, medicines, or inherited conditions and can

affect learning, safety, communication, and daily activities.

Vision Impairment

Alternate name; see *Visual Impairment*.

Vision Loss

A decrease in the ability to see that cannot be fully corrected with eyeglasses, contact lenses, or medical treatment. It ranges from partial impairment to complete blindness and can result from conditions such as macular degeneration, glaucoma, diabetic retinopathy, cataracts, and traumatic injury.

Vision Problems

Changes in visual acuity, field, color, or clarity caused by refractive error, eye disease, neurologic disease, or systemic illness. Sudden vision loss can result from serious retinal, optic-nerve, or neurologic disease.

Vision Receptors

Light-sensing cells in the retina, mainly rods and cones, that convert light into nerve signals. Rods support dim-light vision, while cones provide color and sharp detail in brighter conditions.

Vision Screening

Brief checks used to find possible eye or vision problems before symptoms are obvious. Newborn checks may detect cataracts or other serious disorders; screening in young children looks for poor vision, misaligned eyes, or risks for reduced vision and leads to a full eye examination when needed.

Vision Test

An examination that measures visual acuity, fields, color, alignment, or eye structures to detect refractive error, retinal disease, optic-nerve dysfunction, glaucoma, or other causes of visual impairment.

Visual Acuity

How clearly a person can see fine details, usually measured by reading letters or symbols at a set distance. It can be reduced by focusing problems, eye disease, or disorders affecting the visual nerves or brain.

Visual Acuity Test

A test measuring the smallest standardized detail a person can resolve at a specified distance, usually reported as a fraction or decimal.

Visual Agnosia

Inability to recognize familiar objects, faces, or symbols by sight even though the eyes may see adequately. It usually results from damage to brain areas that interpret vision, such as after a stroke or head injury.

Visual Evoked Potential

A test that records the brain's electrical response to flashes or changing visual patterns. It helps assess the nerve pathways that carry visual signals from the eyes to the brain.

Alternate Names:
VEP; Visual Evoked Response (VER)

Visual Field

The entire spatial area and perimeter within which visual stimuli are perceived when the eye and head remain fixed in a stationary forward gaze. Measured clinically and perimetrically (automated Humphrey visual field perimetry or Goldmann kinetic perimetry), the normal monocular visual field extends approximately 60 degrees superiorly, 70 degrees inferiorly, 60 degrees nasally, and 100 degrees temporally. Characteristic visual field defects localize neuro-ophthalmic pathology: altitudinal defects in anterior ischemic optic neuropathy; bitemporal hemianopia in optic chiasm lesions (pituitary adenoma); homonymous hemianopia in contralateral retrochiasmal optic tract or optic radiation/occipital cortex lesions; and peripheral concentric constrictions (tunnel vision) in advanced open-angle glaucoma or retinitis pigmentosa.

Alternate Names:
Visual Fields

Visual Field Defect

Loss or change in part of the area a person can see

while looking straight ahead. It may result from disease of the retina, optic nerve, or brain, and the pattern can help identify where the problem is.

Visual Field Perimetry

A test that maps how well a person sees in different parts of the visual field while looking at a fixed point. It can detect and monitor missing areas caused by eye-nerve, retinal, or brain disease.

Visual Fields

Plural form; see *Visual Field*.

Visual Field Test

A test that measures central and side vision and maps areas that are missing or less sensitive.

Visual Impairment

Reduced vision that cannot be fully corrected by ordinary glasses or contact lenses. Causes include refractive error, cataract, glaucoma, retinal disease, optic-nerve injury, and disorders of the brain or nervous system.

Visualized Laser-Assisted Prostatectomy

A procedure that uses a laser, guided by a camera, to remove or vaporize prostate tissue blocking urine flow. It is used for some people with an enlarged prostate and may cause bleeding, infection, scar narrowing, or temporary urinary and sexual problems.

Alternate Names:
VLAP

Visual Neglect

A brain disorder in which a person fails to notice or respond to things on one side, even though the eyes may work normally. It often follows a stroke affecting the right side of the brain and causes neglect of the left side.

Alternate Names:
Hemispatial Neglect; Spatial Inattention

Vital

Essential for life or relating to vital physiologic functions. Vital signs commonly include temperature, pulse, respiratory rate, blood pressure, and oxygen saturation.

Vital Capacity

The greatest amount of air a person can breathe out after filling the lungs as fully as possible. It is measured during lung-function testing and may be reduced by lung disease, weak breathing muscles, or restriction of chest movement.

Vitalography

Regional or educational term for spirometry; see *Spirometry*.

Vital Signs

Basic measurements of physiologic status, commonly including temperature, pulse, respiratory rate, blood pressure, and oxygen saturation. Values vary with age, activity, illness, and measurement conditions; trends and clinical context are important.

Vitamin A

A fat-soluble nutrient needed for vision, immune function, growth, and healthy tissues. Retinol is a major form; deficiency can impair vision, while excess preformed vitamin A can injure the liver and developing fetus.

Vitamin A Blood Test

A blood test measuring circulating retinol, used to assess suspected vitamin A deficiency or toxicity in appropriate clinical settings.

Vitamin A Deficiency

A nutritional disorder resulting from inadequate intake or absorption of vitamin A (retinol), causing dry eyes (xerophthalmia), night blindness, dry skin, and weakened immunity. Severe deficiency leads to corneal ulceration and is the leading cause of preventable childhood blindness worldwide; clinical eye stages are categorized using the WHO xerophthalmia classification.

Alternate Names:
Hypovitaminosis A; Retinol Deficiency; Vitamin A

Lack

Vitamin A: Retinal

Retinal (retinaldehyde) is a form of vitamin A made from retinol. In the eye, it binds to opsin proteins to form light-sensitive pigments in rod and cone cells.

Vitamin A Toxicity

Harm caused by taking too much vitamin A or related medicines. It may cause nausea, vomiting, headache, dry skin, hair loss, liver injury, high calcium levels, and serious fetal abnormalities during pregnancy.

Vitamin B

Vitamin B refers to a group of water-soluble vitamins that support energy metabolism, blood-cell formation, nerve function, and other processes. The group includes several distinct vitamins, not one single substance.

Vitamin B1

Thiamine, a water-soluble vitamin that acts as a cofactor in carbohydrate and amino-acid metabolism and supports nerve function. Severe deficiency can cause beriberi or Wernicke encephalopathy.

Alternate Names:
Thiamine; Aneurin

Vitamin B12

A vitamin needed for red blood cell formation, DNA production, and normal nerve function. Deficiency can cause anemia, numbness, balance problems, or cognitive changes.

Alternate Names:
Cobalamin

Vitamin B12: Cobalamin

Alternate name; see *Vitamin B12*.

Vitamin B12 Deficiency

Too little vitamin B12, which can cause large abnormal red cells, tiredness, numbness, balance problems, or nerve damage. Causes include poor intake, poor absorption, autoimmune disease, stomach surgery, and medicines.

Vitamin B12 Deficiency Anemia

Anemia caused by too little vitamin B12 or poor absorption of it. It can cause tiredness, pale skin, a sore tongue, numbness, balance problems, and permanent nerve damage if untreated for a long time.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin B12 Deficiency Anaemia

Vitamin B12 Deficiency In Older Adults

Deficiency caused by inadequate intake, malabsorption, autoimmune intrinsic-factor deficiency, gastric surgery, or medications. It may cause megaloblastic anemia, neuropathy, cognitive changes, gait impairment, and glossitis; neurologic injury can occur without anemia.

Vitamin B12 Level

The amount of vitamin B12 measured in blood; results are interpreted with symptoms and related tests because serum levels may not fully reflect tissue deficiency.

Vitamin B12 Test

A blood test measuring circulating cobalamin to detect deficiency, which can cause megaloblastic anemia and peripheral neuropathy; see *Vitamin B12*.

Vitamin B1: Thiamine

Alternate name; see *Vitamin B1*.

Vitamin B2

Riboflavin, a water-soluble vitamin that helps cells produce energy and supports healthy skin, eyes, and the lining of the mouth. Deficiency can cause cracks at the mouth corners, a sore tongue, skin changes, or anemia.

Alternate Names:
Riboflavin; Lactoflavin

Vitamin B2 Riboflavin

Alternate name; see *Riboflavin*.

Vitamin B3

Niacin, a water-soluble vitamin that helps cells use food for energy and supports normal skin and nervous-system function. Severe deficiency causes pellagra, which can include diarrhea, skin inflammation, and neurologic problems.

Alternate Names:
Niacin

Vitamin B5

A water-soluble vitamin needed to help the body use fats, carbohydrates, and proteins and make hormones and other substances. It is found in many foods, so deficiency is rare; very large supplement doses may cause stomach upset.

Alternate Names:
Pantothenate; Calcium Pantothenate

Vitamin B6

A group of related compounds needed for amino-acid metabolism, red-cell production, and nerve function. Pyridoxine is one form; excess supplemental vitamin B6 can cause sensory nerve damage.

Vitamin B6: Pyridoxine

Alternate name; see *Vitamin B6*.

Vitamin B7

A vitamin that helps the body use fats, carbohydrates, and proteins. Deficiency is uncommon but may cause hair loss, skin rash, or neurologic symptoms; large doses can interfere with some laboratory tests.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin H; Coenzyme R

Vitamin B9

A vitamin needed for DNA production and healthy red blood cells. Deficiency can cause large-cell anemia and, during pregnancy, is associated with a higher risk of neural-tube defects. Folate is the natural form; folic acid is a commonly used synthetic form.

Alternate Names:
Folic Acid; Pteroylglutamic Acid

Vitamin B Complex

A group of eight water-soluble vitamins: thiamine (B1), riboflavin (B2), niacin (B3), pantothenic acid (B5), vitamin B6, biotin (B7), folate (B9), and vitamin B12. They support processes such as energy metabolism, blood-cell formation, and nerve function. Each has distinct roles and deficiency effects.

Alternate Names:
B Vitamins; Vitamin B Group

Vitamin C

A water-soluble vitamin needed for collagen formation, wound healing, immune function, antioxidant activity, and absorption of iron from plant foods. Severe deficiency causes scurvy, with bleeding gums, bruising, poor wound healing, and weakness.

Alternate Names:
Ascorbic Acid

Vitamin C Deficiency

Too little vitamin C, usually after prolonged low intake. Severe deficiency causes scurvy, with bleeding gums, easy bruising, poor wound healing, joint pain, and weakness.

Vitamin D

Vitamin D supports calcium and phosphate balance, bone mineralization, muscle function, and immune processes; deficiency causes rickets in children and osteomalacia or bone loss in adults.

Vitamin D3

Cholecalciferol, a form of vitamin D made in skin and found in some foods and supplements. It helps the body absorb calcium and maintain healthy bones.

Vitamin D: Calcitriol

Alternate name; see *Calcitriol*. Calcitriol is the active hormone form of vitamin D, not another name for vitamin D as a whole.

Vitamin D Deficiency

Too little vitamin D for the body's needs. It can result from low intake or sunlight, poor absorption,

or liver or kidney disease and may weaken bones, cause muscle weakness, or lead to rickets in children.

Vitamin Deficiency Anemia

Anemia caused by a shortage of vitamins needed to make red blood cells, most commonly vitamin B12 or folate. The blood-cell changes and other effects depend on the vitamin; vitamin B12 deficiency can also damage nerves, sometimes even without anemia.

Vitamin D Test

A blood test measuring 25-hydroxyvitamin D to evaluate bone health, calcium regulation, and nutritional status; see *Vitamin D*.

Vitamin E

A group of fat-soluble compounds, including tocopherols and tocotrienols, with antioxidant activity. Alpha-tocopherol is the main form maintained in the human body. High-dose supplements can increase bleeding risk and interact with medicines.

Vitamin E Deficiency

Deficiency of a fat-soluble antioxidant vitamin, usually caused by fat-malabsorption disorders or rare inherited conditions. Severe deficiency can cause peripheral neuropathy, ataxia, muscle weakness, retinal dysfunction, or hemolytic anemia.

Vitamin E: Tocopherol

Tocopherols are one group of compounds with vitamin E activity; see *Vitamin E*.

Vitamin K

A fat-soluble vitamin needed to activate several blood-clotting proteins and support bone metabolism. Phylloquinone, the main dietary form, is found in leafy green vegetables and some vegetable oils. Deficiency can cause abnormal bleeding.

Vitamin K Deficiency

Too little vitamin K for normal production of clotting factors, causing an increased bleeding tendency. It can result from poor intake, malabsorption, liver disease, or certain medicines; newborns receive vitamin K prophylaxis.

Vitamin K Deficiency Bleeding

Bleeding in a newborn or young infant caused by inadequate vitamin K-dependent clotting activity. It may occur early, classically, or late and can involve the brain or gastrointestinal tract.

Alternate Names:
VKDB

Vitamin K: Phylloquinone

Phylloquinone is the main dietary form of vitamin K; see *Vitamin K*.

Vitamin K Prophylaxis

Giving vitamin K to a newborn soon after birth to prevent bleeding caused by vitamin K deficiency.

Vitamins

Organic nutrients needed in small amounts for normal metabolism, growth, and tissue maintenance; some are water-soluble and others fat-soluble, and both deficiency and excess can cause disease.

Vitamin Toxicity

Harm caused by excessive vitamin intake, most often involving fat-soluble vitamins that can accumulate in the body. Excess vitamin A can injure the liver and developing fetus; excess vitamin D can raise blood calcium; and high-dose vitamin E can increase bleeding risk.

Vitiligo

A chronic autoimmune skin condition in which the immune system mistakenly attacks and destroys melanocytes, the cells responsible for producing skin pigment (melanin). As these pigment-producing cells are lost, smooth, chalky-white patches develop on various areas of the skin, hair, and mucous membranes. It can affect any part of the body, most frequently appearing symmetrically on the face, hands, wrists, and around body openings, and does not cause physical pain or skin shedding.

Alternate Names:

Leukoderma; Autoimmune Depigmentation

Vitrectomy

Eye surgery that removes some or all of the vitreous, the clear gel that fills the middle of the eye. Small instruments are inserted through the wall of the eye to remove cloudy gel, blood, scar tissue, or a foreign object and to repair problems of the retina. It may be used for retinal detachment, diabetic eye disease, macular hole, macular pucker, severe eye injury, or serious eye infection. The removed gel may be replaced with a salt solution, air or gas, or silicone oil.

Vitreoretinal Surgery

The surgical subspecialty concerned with disorders of the retina and vitreous, the clear gel filling the back of the eye. Procedures include vitrectomy, retinal detachment repair, and surgery for macular holes or complications of diabetic eye disease. It may also involve laser or other techniques to treat retinal and vitreous disorders.

Alternate Names:
Vitreo-Retinal Surgery; Retinal Surgery

Vitreous

Relating to the transparent gel filling most of the space between the lens and retina, or describing a glass-like appearance. Vitreous disorders can cause floaters, hemorrhage, detachment, or retinal traction.

Vitreous Body

The transparent gel filling the large space between the lens and retina. It helps maintain the shape of the eye and transmits light; age-related liquefaction can cause floaters or contribute to retinal traction.

Alternate Names:
Corpus Vitreum

Vitreous Detachment

Separation of the vitreous gel from the retina, usually related to aging and often causing new floaters or flashes. Sudden symptoms can occur with a retinal tear or detachment.

Alternate Names:
Posterior Vitreous Detachment; PVD

Vitreous Hemorrhage

Bleeding into the vitreous cavity that causes sudden painless floaters, cobwebs, haze, or loss of vision. Common causes include proliferative diabetic retinopathy, retinal tear or detachment, trauma, and posterior vitreous separation.

Vitreous Humor

Alternate name; see *Vitreous Body*.

VKORC1 Polymorphism

An inherited variation in the vitamin K epoxide reductase complex subunit 1 gene that can alter sensitivity to warfarin. Genotype may contribute to dose selection, but clinical factors, interacting medicines, diet, and INR monitoring remain important.

VLDL Test

A blood test that measures or estimates very-low-density lipoprotein, a particle carrying triglycerides. The result may help assess cardiovascular risk but is interpreted with the full cholesterol and triglyceride profile.

VO2 Max

The greatest amount of oxygen the body can use during intense exercise. It is a measure of aerobic fitness and is influenced by the heart, lungs, blood, muscles, age, health, and training.

Alternate Names:
Maximal Oxygen Consumption; Maximal Aerobic Capacity

Vocal Cord Disorders

Disorders affecting the vocal folds or their nerves, including nodules, polyps, cysts, inflammation, paralysis, and spasmodic dysphonia. They may cause hoarseness, voice loss, throat discomfort, noisy breathing, or difficulty swallowing.

Vocal Cord Dysfunction

Older name; see *Inducible Laryngeal Obstruction*.

Vocal-Cord Dysfunction

Older name; see *Inducible Laryngeal Obstruction*.

Vocal Cord Nodules

Small, noncancerous thickened areas on the vocal folds inside the voice box, often caused by repeated voice strain. They can cause hoarseness, a tired voice, or a rough or breathy sound.

Vocal Cord Paralysis

One or both folds in the voice box cannot move normally, often because of nerve damage. It may cause hoarseness, a weak cough, choking, or trouble keeping food and drink out of the windpipe.

Alternate Names:
Vocal Fold Paralysis

Vocal Cord Paresis

Weakness or partial paralysis of one or both vocal cords, often from injury to the nerves that control them. It can cause a weak or breathy voice, voice fatigue, coughing during eating, or aspiration.

Vocal Cord Polyp

A usually noncancerous growth on a vocal fold inside the voice box, sometimes after heavy or sudden voice use. It can cause lasting hoarseness, a rough voice, or a tired voice.

Vocal Cord Polyps

Alternate name; see *Vocal Cord Polyp*.

Vocal Cords

Alternate name; see *Vocal Folds*.

Vocal-Fold Nodules

Alternate name; see *Vocal Cord Nodules*.

Vocal Fold Paralysis

Alternate name; see *Vocal Cord Paralysis*.

Vocal-Fold Polyps

Alternate name for vocal cord polyps, usually noncancerous growths on the vocal folds that can cause persistent hoarseness or voice fatigue.

Vocal Folds

Two folds inside the voice box that vibrate as air passes between them to make sound. They also close during swallowing to protect the lungs from food and liquid.

Vocal Hemorrhage

Vocal hemorrhage is bleeding into a vocal fold, often after sudden or forceful voice use. It can cause abrupt hoarseness.

Vocal Nodules

Benign thickened areas on the vocal folds, usually caused by repeated voice strain. They can cause hoarseness, a rough or breathy voice, vocal fatigue, and loss of vocal range.

Vocal Resonance

The sound of a person's voice heard through the chest with a stethoscope while they speak. Changes in the sound can provide clues to pneumonia, fluid around the lung, a collapsed lung, or other lung disease.

Vogt-Koyanagi-Harada Disease

A rare autoimmune disease affecting both eyes and other organs. It causes inflammation inside the eyes, often with fluid beneath the retina, and may also affect hearing, the meninges, and skin or hair pigment.

Alternate Names:
VKH Syndrome; Uveomeningoencephalitic Syndrome

Vogt-Koyanagi-Harada Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Vogt-Koyanagi-Harada Disease*.

Vohwinkel Syndrome

A rare inherited palmoplantar keratoderma causing thick skin on the palms and soles, constricting bands around fingers or toes, and sometimes hearing loss or other features. Severe constriction can threaten circulation and requires specialist care.

Voice

Sound produced by vibration of the vocal folds as air passes through the larynx, then shaped by the throat, mouth, and nose for speech.

Voice And Speech

The products of complex coordinated activity of the respiratory, laryngeal, and articulatory systems. Communication produced by coordinated breathing, voice-box vibration, and movements of the mouth, tongue, and other speech structures.

Voice Box

The larynx, an organ in the neck containing the vocal folds and forming part of the airway. It produces voice and helps protect the lower respiratory tract during swallowing.

Voice Disorders

Conditions affecting voice quality, pitch, loudness, or ease of speaking because of problems involving the vocal folds, airway, nerves, or voice use.

Void

To empty the urinary bladder by urinating; in other medical contexts, void may mean an empty space or absence of a substance.

Voiding Cystourethrogram

An X-ray test that fills the bladder with contrast through a catheter and records the bladder and urethra while the person urinates. It can show urine flowing backward toward the kidneys, blockage, leakage, or structural problems, especially in children with selected urinary infections.

Volar

Relating to the palm of the hand or sole of the foot, especially the surface opposite the dorsum.

Volatile Anesthetics

Inhaled medicines used to produce and maintain unconsciousness during some operations. They can lower blood pressure and breathing and rarely cause a dangerous rise in body temperature in susceptible people.

Alternate Names:
Inhalational Anesthetics; Inhalation General Anesthetics

Volkmann Contracture

A permanent, severe ischemic contracture of the forearm flexor musculature leading to a claw-like hand deformity, resulting from untreated acute compartment syndrome of the forearm following supracondylar humeral fractures, crush injuries, or tight casting.

Alternate Names:
Volkmann's Ischemic Contracture; Ischemic Myodystrophy

Alternate Names:
Volkmann contracture; Volkmann's ischaemic contracture; Volkmann claw deformity.

Volume Of Distribution

A calculated measure of how widely a medicine appears to spread through the body compared with the amount left in the blood. It helps guide dosing but does not represent a real space inside the body.

Volume Overload

Excess sodium and water in the body, which can cause swelling in tissues or fluid in the lungs. Causes include heart, kidney, or liver disease and excessive fluid administration.

Voluntary

Under conscious control or performed by choice, such as voluntary movement. Voluntary action is distinguished from reflex, autonomic, or involuntary activity.

Voluntary Psychiatric Admission

Admission to a hospital or psychiatric facility with the person's agreement for assessment, treatment, or safety support. Legal rules about consent, leaving, capacity, and conversion to involuntary status vary by jurisdiction.

Volutrauma

Lung injury caused by overstretching the lungs, usually when a breathing machine delivers breaths that are too large. Careful ventilator settings can reduce this risk.

Volvulus

Twisting of a loop of intestine that blocks passage through the bowel and may cut off its blood supply. It can cause severe pain, vomiting, swelling, and tissue death and can be life-threatening.

Vomit

To eject stomach or upper gastrointestinal contents through the mouth; the expelled material may also be called vomitus. Persistent vomiting can cause dehydration and electrolyte abnormalities.

Vomiting

Forceful emptying of stomach contents through the mouth. It may result from infection, digestive disease, medicines, pregnancy, migraine, brain disorders, or poisoning. Repeated vomiting can cause dehydration, disturbed body salts, or inhalation of vomit.

Vomiting Blood

The passage of blood or coffee-ground material in vomit, usually indicating bleeding in the upper digestive tract. It can be a serious symptom.

Vomitus

Material expelled from the stomach or upper gastrointestinal tract during vomiting. Its color and contents can provide clues but do not by themselves establish a diagnosis.

Von Economo Encephalitis

A historical epidemic form of encephalitis lethargica associated with excessive sleepiness, eye-movement problems, and later parkinsonism. It is distinct from African sleeping sickness, which is caused by a parasite.

Alternate Names:
Encephalitis Lethargica; Sleeping Sickness (Von Economo Type)

Von Gierke Disease

Glycogen storage disease type I, an inherited deficiency of glucose-6-phosphatase or its transport system that causes fasting hypoglycemia, lactic acidosis, enlarged liver, and excess uric acid or lipids.

Von Graefe Sign

A delay of the upper eyelid as the eyes look downward, leaving a strip of white visible above the iris. It can occur with an overactive thyroid and related eye disease.

Alternate Names:
Lid Lag Sign; Von Graefe's Lid Lag

Von Hippel-Lindau Disease

An inherited condition, usually caused by a change in the *VHL* gene, that increases the risk of tumors and cysts in the brain, spinal cord, eyes, kidneys, adrenal glands, and pancreas. These growths can affect vision, blood pressure, or kidney function.

Von Hippel-Lindau Syndrome

Von Hippel-Lindau syndrome is an inherited disorder caused by changes in the VHL gene. It increases the risk of tumors and cysts in organs such as the brain, retina, kidneys, pancreas, and adrenal glands.

Von Meyenburg Complex

A benign congenital biliary ductal plate malformation (biliary microhamartoma) consisting of small, non-progressive clusters of dilated, cystic bile ducts embedded in a dense collagenous stroma, usually discovered incidentally on liver imaging or biopsy.

Alternate Names:
Biliary Microhamartoma; Ductal Plate Malformation

Von Recklinghausen Disease

Von Recklinghausen disease is another name for neurofibromatosis type 1, an inherited condition causing multiple café-au-lait spots, neurofibromas, and increased risk of certain nerve, bone, eye, and other problems.

Von Recklinghausen'S Disease

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

Von Recklinghausen'S Neurofibromatosis

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

Von Recklinghausen'S Phakomatosis

Alternate name; see *Neurofibromatosis Type 1*.

Von Rosen Splint

A malleable, lightweight orthopedic abduction splint applied in neonates with developmental dysplasia of the hip (DDH) to maintain the femoral head securely centered within the acetabulum in flexion and abduction.

Alternate Names:
Von Rosen Frame; DDH Abduction Splint

Von Willebrand Disease

The most common inherited bleeding disorder, caused by a deficiency or malfunction of von Willebrand factor, an essential blood protein that helps platelets stick together to form clots and protects other vital clotting proteins in the blood. People with this condition have difficulty stopping bleeding after an injury, surgery, or dental work, and commonly experience frequent or prolonged nosebleeds, easy bruising, and heavy menstrual bleeding.

Alternate Names:
vWD; Von Willebrand's Disease; Pseudohemophilia

Voriconazole

A triazole antifungal medicine used for selected serious fungal infections. It blocks ergosterol production in fungal cell membranes; adverse effects can include visual changes, liver injury, drug interactions, and skin sensitivity.

VOR Reflex

A reflex that moves the eyes opposite to head movement so vision stays steady while the head turns. Problems with this reflex can cause blurred or bouncing vision, dizziness, or imbalance.

Voyeurism

A recurrent sexual interest in observing an unsuspecting person who is naked, disrobing, or engaging in sexual activity. The interest alone is not a mental disorder; voyeuristic disorder is the diagnostic term when required criteria are met.

Voyeuristic Disorder

A paraphilic disorder involving intense, recurrent sexual arousal from observing an unsuspecting person who is naked, disrobing, or engaging in sexual activity. Diagnostic criteria include acting on the urges with a nonconsenting person or experiencing significant distress or impairment; the pattern lasts at least six months and the person diagnosed is at least 18 years old.

VPCs (Ventricular Premature Contractions)

Alternate name; see *Premature Ventricular Contraction*.

VRE Infection

An infection caused by vancomycin-resistant enterococci, bacteria that commonly live in the intestine but can cause urinary-tract, wound, bloodstream, heart-valve, or other infections. Treatment depends on the infection site and susceptibility testing because usual antibiotics may not work.

VRE (Vancomycin-Resistant Enterococci)

Enterococcus bacteria that are no longer killed by vancomycin, an antibiotic. They may colonize the intestine without causing illness or cause urinary, wound, bloodstream, or other infections.

VSD

Alternate name; see *Ventricular Septal Defect*.

Vulnerary

A substance traditionally believed to help heal wounds. Such products may lack good evidence and can cause allergy or contamination.

Vulva

The external female genital structures, including the mons pubis, labia, clitoris, and vestibule. It protects the openings of the urinary and reproductive tracts and contains specialized sensory and glandular tissue.

Alternate Names:
Female External Genitalia; Pudendum

Vulval Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Alternate spelling; see *Vulvar Intraepithelial Neoplasia*.

Vulvar

Relating to the vulva, the external female genital structures including the labia, clitoris, vestibule, and associated glands.

Vulvar Cancer

Cancer arising in the external female genitalia. It may appear as a persistent lump, ulcer, wart-like lesion, itching, pain, or bleeding.

Vulvar Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Vulvar Cancer*.

Vulvar Inclusion Cysts

Small sacs under the skin of the vulva that contain tissue trapped from the surface lining. They may develop after childbirth tears, surgery, or other injury, or occur without an obvious cause. Most cause no symptoms, but they may become swollen, painful, infected, or uncomfortable during sexual activity. Symptomatic cysts may need removal.

Vulvar Intraepithelial Neoplasia

Abnormal cells limited to the surface layer of the vulva. The risk of progression to invasive cancer varies by subtype and is higher for differentiated vulvar intraepithelial neoplasia than for usual-type disease. It may cause itching, burning, sores, growths, or color change, but can also cause no symptoms.

Vulvar Melanoma

A rare melanoma arising in the vulva, the external female genital area. It may appear as a dark, light, or variably colored lump or patch, or as a sore that itches, hurts, or bleeds. A biopsy is needed to diagnose it.

Vulvar Squamous Cell Carcinoma

The most common invasive vulvar malignancy, arising through HPV-related or HPV-independent pathways. It usually presents as a persistent mass, ulcer, plaque, or wart-like lesion; biopsy establishes the diagnosis.

Vulvectomy

Surgical removal of part or all of the vulva, performed for selected cancers, precancerous lesions, or severe persistent disease.

Vulvitis

Inflammation or irritation of the external female genital area. It can cause itching, burning, redness, swelling, soreness, or discharge and may result from infection, allergy, skin disease, hormones, or friction.

Vulvodynia

Persistent or recurring pain in the vulva without an identifiable cause or specific disorder. The pain may be localized or widespread, triggered by touch or pressure, or occur without touch; it is often described as burning, rawness, or soreness.

Alternate Names:
Chronic Vulvar Pain

Vulvovaginal Candidiasis

Inflammation of the vulva and vagina caused by symptomatic overgrowth of Candida yeasts, usually *C. albicans*; Candida may also be present without causing symptoms. It commonly causes itching, soreness, redness or swelling, external burning with urination, pain during sex, and sometimes thick white discharge, but these symptoms are not specific. It is not usually sexually transmitted; recurrent disease generally means three or more symptomatic episodes in less than a year.

Vulvovaginitis

Inflammation or infection of the vulva and vagina.

It may cause itching, burning, pain with urination or sex, or unusual discharge. Causes include yeast, some bacteria or parasites, low estrogen, allergies, and irritating products.

Alternate Names:
Vaginitis and Vulvitis; Vulvovaginal Inflammation

W

Waardenburg Syndrome

A group of inherited neural-crest disorders characterized by congenital sensorineural hearing loss and variable pigmentary changes of the iris, hair, and skin, including heterochromia and a white forelock. Depending on the type, features may include dystopia canthorum, limb abnormalities, or Hirschsprung disease; inheritance may be dominant or recessive.

Waddell Signs

A group of examination responses sometimes seen during assessment of low back pain, including tenderness, simulated pain tests, and findings that do not follow typical anatomy. They are not a test for malingering and do not by themselves show that pain is psychological.

WAGR Syndrome

A genetic condition, usually caused by deletion of part of chromosome 11, associated with Wilms tumor, aniridia, genitourinary differences, and developmental delay. The findings and tumor risk vary among affected children.

Waist Circumference

The distance around the abdomen measured with a tape at a specified anatomical level. In the World Health Organization protocol, the tape is placed midway between the lowest palpable rib and the top of the hip bone (iliac crest). The measurement estimates abdominal fat and cardiometabolic risk; interpretation uses cutoffs that vary by sex and population.

Waist-Hip Ratio

A measurement comparing waist size with hip size. It provides an estimate of where body fat is stored and may add information about diabetes and cardiovascular risk, but it does not diagnose disease by itself.

Wait List

A list of candidates registered to receive an organ transplant. Placement and allocation priority are determined by the applicable transplant system and may consider medical urgency, expected benefit, blood or tissue compatibility, organ size, waiting time, and other policy-based factors; it is not necessarily a simple first-come, first-served queue.

Alternate Names:
Waiting List; Transplant Waiting List; Transplant Waitlist

Wakefulness

The state of being conscious and able to respond to the surroundings. Sleep, medicines, illness, brain injury, and metabolic problems can change the level of wakefulness.

Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia

A rare, slow-growing type of blood cancer (a form of non-Hodgkin lymphoma) in which abnormal white blood cells multiply in the bone marrow. These cancerous cells produce excessive amounts of a large antibody protein called immunoglobulin M (IgM). The buildup of this bulky protein can thicken the blood (hyperviscosity), causing impaired circulation that leads to nosebleeds, blurred vision, headaches, fatigue, and numbness in the extremities.

Alternate Names:
Lymphoplasmacytic Lymphoma with IgM Paraproteinemia; Waldenström Macroglobulinemia

Waldenstrom's Macroglobulinemia

Alternate name; see *Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia*.

Waldenström's Macroglobulinemia

Alternate spelling; see *Waldenstrom Macroglobulinemia*.

Waldeyer Ring

An annular anatomical arrangement of lymphoid tissue surrounding the opening of the pharynx and nasal cavity, consisting of the pharyngeal tonsils (adenoids), tubal tonsils, palatine tonsils, and lingual tonsils. It functions as the first line of immune defense against ingested or inhaled pathogens.

Alternate Names:
Waldeyer Lymphatic Ring; Pharyngeal Lymphoid Ring

Walker-Warburg Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder causing severe muscle weakness together with major abnormalities of the brain and eyes from birth. Babies may have low muscle tone, seizures, poor feeding, enlarged fluid spaces in the brain, and abnormal eye development; the condition is usually life-threatening in infancy.

Alternate Names:
WWS; HARD +/- E Syndrome

Walking Abnormalities

Walking abnormalities include changes in speed, balance, stride, posture, or coordination caused by pain, weakness, sensory loss, joint disease, or neurologic illness.

Walking Pneumonia

An informal term for a usually mild pneumonia that does not prevent a person from carrying on many daily activities. It is often associated with *Mycoplasma pneumoniae*, but the term does not identify a specific cause.

Walking Speed

The rate at which a person walks, often measured over a defined distance. It can provide information about mobility and function, but no single speed determines disability in every person.

Wallenberg Syndrome

A neurological condition caused by infarction of the lateral medulla oblongata, most commonly resulting from occlusion of the posterior inferior cerebellar artery (PICA) or vertebral artery. Manifestations include ipsilateral facial sensory loss, Horner syndrome, ataxia, dysphagia, hoarseness, and contralateral loss of pain and temperature sensation in the trunk and limbs.

Alternate Names:
Lateral Medullary Syndrome; PICA Syndrome; Posterior Inferior Cerebellar Artery Syndrome

Wallerian Degeneration

Breakdown of the part of an axon beyond a nerve injury after it loses contact with the nerve cell. In peripheral nerves, this process clears damaged axon and myelin and can support later regrowth; regeneration in the central nervous system is much more limited.

Walleyed

An older, informal term for outward turning of one or both eyes, medically called exotropia.

Wall Stress

The force acting on a heart chamber's wall, influenced by pressure inside the chamber, its size, and wall thickness. Increased wall stress makes the heart work harder and can contribute to remodeling or failure.

Wandering Rash Tongue

A common name for geographic tongue, a benign inflammatory condition in which smooth red patches with pale borders move across the tongue. It is not contagious and may cause sensitivity to spicy or acidic foods.

Wandering Spleen

A spleen that can move unusually because its supporting bands are loose or missing. It may cause no symptoms or lead to abdominal pain, enlargement, twisting, loss of blood supply, or sudden severe illness.

Warburg Effect

The tendency of many cancer cells to take up glucose and convert much of it to lactate even when oxygen is available. This pattern can occur alongside mitochondrial energy production and supports the cells' growth and metabolism.

Warfarin

An anticoagulant that reduces production of vitamin-K-dependent clotting proteins. It prevents and treats blood clots but can cause major or fatal bleeding. Its effect is measured with the international normalized ratio (INR), because diet, illness, and many medicines can alter INR and bleeding risk.

Warfarin and Superwarfarin Toxicity

Harm from excessive exposure to warfarin or a long-acting related rodenticide. It can prevent blood from clotting normally and cause bleeding, sometimes after a delay.

Warfarin-Induced Skin Necrosis

A rare complication in which small blood clots block vessels in the skin, causing painful red or purple areas that may progress to tissue death. It usually begins within days of starting warfarin and is associated with an imbalance in clotting proteins, including protein C.

Warfarin Syndrome

A pattern of fetal abnormalities caused by warfarin exposure during pregnancy, including nasal and skeletal abnormalities, eye or neurologic defects, and fetal or neonatal bleeding.

Warm and Cold Autoantibodies

Antibodies that bind to a person's red blood cells most effectively at warmer or colder temperatures. They can interfere with laboratory testing and, in some cases, cause red-cell destruction and anemia.

Warm Autoimmune Hemolytic Anemia

A disorder in which warm-reactive antibodies cause red blood cells to be destroyed prematurely, mainly in the spleen. It can cause anemia, jaundice, dark urine, shortness of breath, or a fast heartbeat.

Alternate Names:
wAIHA; Warm Antibody Hemolytic Anemia

Warm Ischemia

Lack of blood and oxygen reaching tissue while it remains at body temperature. It can quickly cause cell damage and is important during some injuries, operations, and organ transplantation.

Wart

A usually harmless rough skin growth caused by human papillomavirus. Warts may spread by contact and often disappear over time. Common types include common, plantar, and flat warts; appearance and symptoms vary by site.

Alternate Names:
Verruca

Warthin Tumor

A usually harmless tumor of a salivary gland, most often the parotid near the ear. It is strongly associated with tobacco use and may occur on both sides; evaluation distinguishes it from other growths.

Alternate Names:
Warthin's Tumor; Papillary Cystadenoma Lymphomatosum; Adenolymphoma

Wart Remover Poisoning

Toxic exposure to a wart-removal product, often involving salicylic acid or another keratolytic. Severity depends on the substance, amount, route, symptoms, and duration of exposure.

Warts and Plantar Warts

Alternate name; see *Wart* and *Plantar Wart*.

Warty Dyskeratoma

A usually harmless skin growth, often on the head or neck, with a small central dip filled with keratin. It can resemble skin cancer, and biopsy findings distinguish the conditions.

Wasting

Abnormal loss of body weight, muscle, or other tissue, often associated with chronic disease, inadequate nutrition, inflammation, or cancer. Severe wasting may impair strength, immunity, and recovery.

Watchful Waiting

Planned observation without immediate active treatment, with clinical review and treatment if symptoms develop or the condition progresses. It may be used for selected cancers and other slowly progressive conditions.

Water Birth

Delivery of a baby while the birthing person is immersed in water. This differs from water immersion during the first stage of labor; evidence about the benefits and risks of underwater delivery remains limited.

Alternate Names:
Aquatic Delivery

Water Blister

A blister containing clear fluid, usually caused by friction, pressure, a burn, or a skin disorder.

Waterborne Bacterial Disease

An infection acquired from water contaminated with bacteria, such as cholera, typhoid fever, or leptospirosis; prevention depends on safe water, sanitation, and food hygiene.

Water-Borne Disease

An illness acquired through water contaminated with infectious organisms or harmful chemicals. Examples include cholera, typhoid fever, and hepatitis A.

Water Brash

A sudden increase of watery saliva in the mouth, often associated with gastroesophageal reflux. It may occur with heartburn or a sour taste.

Water Channel

A membrane protein, usually an aquaporin, that allows water to cross a cell membrane. Aquaporins help the kidneys and other tissues regulate water movement.

Water Consumption

Intake of water and other fluids. Fluid requirements vary with body size, diet, activity, climate, pregnancy, illness, and kidney or heart function; excessive intake can cause hyponatremia.

Water-Deprivation Test

A supervised test that restricts water intake while urine concentration and blood sodium or osmolality are measured over time. It helps distinguish causes of excessive dilute urine. The restriction phase usually lasts hours and can extend overnight; dehydration and high blood sodium are potential complications.

Water Hammer Pulse

A bounding pulse that rises forcefully and then collapses rapidly. It may occur with aortic valve leakage or other causes of a wide pulse pressure.

Alternate Names:
Water-Hammer Pulse; Corrigan Pulse; Collapsing Pulse

Water-Hammer Pulse

Alternate spelling; see *Water Hammer Pulse*.

Alternate Names:
Corrigan's Pulse; Collapsing Pulse

Waterhouse-Friderichsen Syndrome

Waterhouse-Friderichsen syndrome is adrenal hemorrhage and acute adrenal failure associated with overwhelming sepsis, classically meningococcal infection, causing shock and coagulopathy.

Water Intoxication

A dangerous fall in blood sodium caused by drinking or retaining more water than the body can remove. Severe cases can cause brain swelling, headache, confusion, seizures, coma, or death.

Water On The Brain

A nontechnical term usually referring to hydrocephalus, an abnormal accumulation or impaired circulation of cerebrospinal fluid that enlarges the ventricles and may increase intracranial pressure.

Water On The Knee

Alternate name; see *Knee Effusion*.

Water Retention

Excess accumulation of fluid in the body's tissues or cavities, commonly causing swelling and sometimes resulting from heart, kidney, liver, venous, hormonal, or medication-related disorders.

Watershed Infarction

Tissue death in a border zone between the areas supplied by two major arteries, most often in the brain. It commonly follows a substantial fall in blood flow or blood pressure; less commonly, it affects the bowel.

Alternate Names:
Border-Zone Infarction

Water-Soluble Vitamin

A vitamin that dissolves in water. The group includes vitamin C and the B vitamins; most are stored in limited amounts, although the body can store vitamin B12 for years.

Waterston Shunt

A historical palliative connection between the ascending aorta and right pulmonary artery that increased blood flow to the lungs in some infants with cyanotic congenital heart disease. It has largely been replaced by other shunt procedures.

Alternate Names:
Waterston-Cooley Anastomosis; Ascending Aorta to Right Pulmonary Artery Shunt

Watery Eyes

Excessive tearing caused by irritation, allergy, infection, reflex tearing from dry eye, or blockage of the tear-drainage system.

Wax

A water-resistant substance produced by ceruminous glands in the ear canal; earwax protects the canal and usually clears naturally.

Wax Poisoning

Toxic exposure to a wax product, usually causing little harm after a small accidental ingestion but potentially causing choking, aspiration, irritation, or toxicity when mixed with other chemicals.

Waxy Casts

Large, smooth, pale tube-shaped particles seen under a microscope in urine. They form in damaged kidney tubules and can suggest severe or long-standing kidney disease, especially when other urine or blood tests are abnormal.

WBC Count

A measurement of the number of white blood cells in a volume of blood, used with the differential count to evaluate infection, inflammation, immune disorders, marrow disease, or treatment effects.

WBS

Abbreviation for Williams-Beuren syndrome, a genetic disorder associated with characteristic facial features, developmental differences, cardiovascular disease, and sometimes high blood calcium.

Weakness

Reduced ability to generate force, which may be generalized or limited to one body region. Causes include disorders of muscle, nerve, neuromuscular junction, brain, or spinal cord, as well as metabolic illness, infection, medication effects, and deconditioning.

Weaning

Gradual reduction and eventual discontinuation of

breastfeeding, bottle-feeding, or a medicine or other treatment, according to the relevant clinical context.

Wear Debris

Tiny particles produced when an artificial joint or other implant wears down. The particles can trigger inflammation, damage nearby bone, loosen the implant, and eventually cause it to fail.

Weaver's Bottom

Older name for ischial bursitis, inflammation of the bursa over the sitting bone that can cause buttock pain, especially with sitting.

Weaver Syndrome

A rare genetic condition causing rapid growth before and after birth, a large head, distinctive facial features, low muscle tone, and delayed development or learning. Bone age may be advanced. Most cases involve a change in the *EZH2* gene.

Webbed Fingers

Partial or complete joining of adjacent fingers by skin or soft tissue, known as syndactyly; it may be congenital or acquired.

Webbed Neck

Extra folds of skin extending from the sides of the neck toward the shoulders. They may be present from birth and can occur with conditions such as Turner syndrome or Noonan syndrome.

Webbing Of The Fingers Or Toes

Partial or complete joining of adjacent fingers or toes by skin or other tissue. It is called syndactyly and may be congenital or acquired.

Weber

Alternate name; see *Weber Test*.

Weber-Christian Disease

An older term for recurrent inflammation of the fat beneath the skin (panniculitis), causing tender nodules and sometimes fever or other systemic symptoms. The term is now used inconsistently; see *Panniculitis*.

Weber Syndrome

A brainstem stroke syndrome caused by occlusion of paramedian branches of the posterior cerebral artery affecting the anterior midbrain. It is characterized by ipsilateral oculomotor (cranial nerve III) palsy and contralateral spastic hemiparesis of the upper and lower extremities.

Alternate Names:
Superior Alternating Hemiplegia; Ventral Midbrain Syndrome

Weber Test

A quick hearing test using a vibrating tuning fork placed on the middle of the forehead or skull. The examiner asks which ear hears the sound louder; the result helps distinguish blockage-related hearing loss from inner-ear or nerve-related loss.

Wedge Excision

Surgical removal of a triangular or wedge-shaped portion of tissue; commonly performed for breast biopsies, cervical lesions, and skin tumors.

Wedge Resection

Surgery that removes a small wedge-shaped piece of tissue, commonly from the lung or breast, to diagnose or treat a localized lesion. It removes less tissue than removal of an entire lobe.

Weever Fish

A venomous marine fish whose dorsal spines can cause a painful sting, local swelling, and occasionally systemic symptoms.

Wegener Granulomatosis

Historical eponym; see *Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis*.

Alternate Names:
Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis; GPA

Wegener's Granulomatosis

Historical eponym; see *Granulomatosis With Polyangiitis*.

Weight-Bearing As Tolerated

An instruction allowing a person to put as much weight on an injured or operated leg as they can tolerate. An assistive device may be used for support.

Alternate Names:
WBAT

Weight Gain

Increase in body weight; may be intentional (muscle building, pregnancy) or unintentional (fluid retention, endocrine disorders, medication effects).

Weight Gain In Pregnancy

Increase in maternal body weight during pregnancy. The expected amount varies with pre-pregnancy body mass index and the number of fetuses.

Weight Gain – Unintentional

Increase in body weight without a planned change in diet or activity. Causes include fluid retention, medicines, endocrine disease, reduced activity, or changes in eating.

Weight Loss

A decrease in body weight that may be intentional or unintentional. Unintentional loss can result from illness, inadequate nutrition, or medication effects.

Weight Loss Medications

Medicines used to reduce body weight in people with obesity, often alongside nutrition and activity changes. They include several drug classes with different mechanisms and adverse effects.

Weight-Loss Medicines

Alternate name; see *Weight Loss Medications*.

Weight Loss Surgery

Weight-loss surgery, or bariatric surgery, changes the stomach or digestive tract to treat severe obesity and related conditions. Long-term effects can include altered nutrient absorption and risk of vitamin or mineral deficiencies.

Weight Management

Long-term approaches to body weight that may involve nutrition, physical activity, behavior change, medicines, or bariatric procedures. It considers health, function, metabolic risk, and weight-related outcomes.

Weight-Reducing Diets

Dietary plans intended to create a sustained energy deficit and reduce excess body weight, ideally individualized with attention to nutrition, health conditions, and long-term adherence.

Weil Disease

The severe form of leptospirosis, involving liver and kidney failure and sometimes bleeding or meningitis.

Weil-Felix Reaction

An older agglutination blood test for some rickettsial infections. It detects antibodies that cross-react with *Proteus vulgaris* OX19 or OX2 antigens or the *Proteus mirabilis* OXK antigen. Its accuracy is limited, and more specific tests are generally used.

Weil-Felix Test

Alternate name; see *Weil-Felix Reaction*.

Alternate Names:
Weil-Felix Agglutination Reaction; Proteus Agglutination Test

Weill-Marchesani Syndrome

A rare inherited connective-tissue disorder that often causes short stature, short fingers and toes, stiff joints, and unusually small, round eye lenses. The lens changes can cause severe nearsightedness or glaucoma. Changes in several genes, including *ADAMTS10*, *ADAMTS17*, *LTBP2*, or *FBN1*, can cause the condition.

Alternate Names:
WMS; Spherophakia-Brachymorphia Syndrome

Weil's Disease

Alternate name; see *Weil Disease*.

Weir-Mitchell Disease

Older name for erythromelalgia, a condition causing episodes of burning pain, redness, and warmth, usually in the hands or feet.

Wellens Syndrome

A specific pattern on an electrocardiogram, often seen after chest pain subsides, associated with critical narrowing of the proximal left anterior descending coronary artery. It signals a high risk of anterior myocardial infarction; exercise stress can precipitate infarction.

Alternate Names:
Wellens Pattern; LAD Coronary T-Wave Syndrome; Wellens Sign

Wells Score

A clinical prediction rule used to estimate the likelihood of deep vein thrombosis (DVT) or pulmonary embolism (PE). Separate versions are used for DVT and PE. The score helps determine whether further testing, such as a D-dimer blood test or imaging, is needed; it does not diagnose or rule out a clot by itself.

Alternate Names:
Wells Criteria; Wells Clinical Score

Wells Score For Pulmonary Embolism

Alternate name; see *Wells Score*.

Wells Syndrome

Eosinophilic cellulitis, an uncommon inflammatory skin disorder causing itchy or burning red plaques, swelling, blisters, or a cellulitis-like eruption without typical bacterial infection. Blood eosinophilia and a skin biopsy may support the diagnosis, and recurrences are possible.

Wells Syndrome (Eosinophilic Cellulitis)

Alternate name; see *Wells Syndrome*.

Welt

A raised, often itchy area of skin caused by localized swelling, commonly seen in hives or after an insect bite. A welt may fade within hours; duration and associated symptoms vary with the cause.

Wen

An informal, imprecise name for a cyst beneath the skin, commonly an epidermoid or pilar cyst. It is not a specific diagnosis.

Wenckebach Phenomenon

A heart-rhythm pattern in which the PR interval lengthens with each beat until one atrial impulse is not conducted to the ventricles. It may occur without heart disease or with an underlying disorder.

Alternate Names:
Second-Degree AV Block Type 1; Mobitz I Block

Wens

Alternate name; see *Wen*.

Werdnig-Hoffmann Disease

The most severe early form of inherited spinal muscular atrophy, also called type 1 spinal muscular atrophy. It usually begins before 6 months of age and causes very weak muscles, poor head control, reduced reflexes, a weak cry, feeding difficulty, and breathing problems. Babies generally cannot sit without support. Disease-modifying treatments can improve survival and motor function.

Alternate Names:
Spinal Muscular Atrophy Type 1 (SMA 1); Severe Infantile Spinal Muscular Atrophy

Werlhof Disease

An older name for immune thrombocytopenia (immune thrombocytopenic purpura), in which immune destruction of platelets can cause bruising, petechiae, nosebleeds, heavy menstrual bleeding, or other bleeding.

Wermer's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 1*.

Wermer Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Type 1*.

Werner's Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Werner Syndrome*.

Werner Syndrome

A rare inherited condition that causes signs of aging earlier than usual, often after puberty. Features may include short stature, early cataracts, thin or tight skin, gray hair, diabetes, weak bones, and increased cancer risk.

Wernicke Aphasia

A language disorder that often causes fluent speech that is difficult to understand, with impaired understanding and repetition of words. It commonly follows damage to language areas in the dominant side of the brain, usually the left hemisphere.

Alternate Names:
Receptive Aphasia; Sensory Aphasia

Wernicke Area

A language network, usually in the dominant hemisphere, involved in understanding spoken and written language. Damage to this network can impair comprehension and produce fluent but difficult-to-understand speech.

Wernicke Encephalopathy

An acute, life-threatening neurological emergency caused by a severe deficiency of thiamine (vitamin B_1), an essential nutrient needed for brain energy metabolism. It most commonly occurs in individuals with severe chronic alcohol use disorder, though it can also result from severe malnutrition, persistent vomiting during pregnancy, or bariatric surgery. The condition classically produces a triad of symptoms: acute mental confusion or apathy, loss of muscle coordination and balance when walking (ataxia), and involuntary eye movements or eye muscle paralysis.

Alternate Names:
Wernicke Disease; Acute Thiamine Deficiency Encephalopathy

Wernicke-Korsakoff Encephalopathy

Alternate name; see *Wernicke-Korsakoff Syndrome*.

Wernicke-Korsakoff Syndrome

A brain disorder caused by severe vitamin B1 deficiency. It may begin with confusion and poor coordination and leave lasting memory problems, difficulty learning, and confabulation, in which a person unintentionally fills memory gaps with inaccurate accounts. Alcohol misuse, poor nutrition, and prolonged vomiting are common causes.

Wernicke'S Area

Alternate spelling; see *Wernicke Area*.

Alternate Names:
Wernicke's Speech Area; Sensory Speech Area

Wernicke's Encephalopathy

Alternate name; see *Wernicke Encephalopathy*.

Westergren Method

The reference laboratory procedure used to determine the erythrocyte sedimentation rate (ESR). Anticoagulated whole blood is placed in an upright, calibrated Westergren tube for one hour, measuring the distance in millimeters that red blood cells settle under gravity to assess systemic inflammation.

Alternate Names:
Westergren ESR; Westergren Sedimentation Technique

Westermark Sign

An area of unusually reduced blood-vessel markings on a chest X-ray, sometimes seen beyond a clot in a lung artery. It may suggest pulmonary embolism but is not reliable enough to diagnose it alone.

Western Blot

A laboratory test that separates proteins and uses antibodies to find a specific protein. It can help study infections, immune reactions, or genetic and research problems, depending on the test.

Alternate Names:
Protein Immunoblot

Westley Croup Score

A clinical score used to estimate how severely croup is obstructing a child's airway. It considers noisy

breathing, chest retractions, air movement, bluish coloring, and alertness; higher scores indicate more severe airway obstruction.

Alternate Names:
Westley Clinical Scoring System for Croup; Croup Severity Score

West Nile Encephalitis

Inflammation of the brain caused by neuroinvasive West Nile virus, transmitted mainly by mosquitoes. It may cause fever, headache, confusion, tremor, weakness, seizures, or coma.

West Nile Fever

A febrile illness caused by West Nile virus, usually transmitted by mosquitoes. Most infections cause no symptoms or a flu-like illness; a small proportion causes neuroinvasive disease such as meningitis, encephalitis, or acute flaccid paralysis.

West Nile Neuroinvasive Disease

A serious form of West Nile virus infection that affects the brain, its coverings, or nerve cells controlling movement. It may cause meningitis, encephalitis, weakness, or acute flaccid paralysis.

Alternate Names:
WNND

West Nile Virus

A mosquito-borne flavivirus that can cause asymptomatic infection, a febrile illness, or neuroinvasive disease such as meningitis, encephalitis, or acute flaccid paralysis. Risk of severe disease is higher in older adults and people with certain medical conditions.

West Nile Virus Infection

West Nile virus infection is a mosquito-borne illness ranging from fever and body aches to neuroinvasive meningitis, encephalitis, weakness, or paralysis.

West Syndrome

An infantile-onset epilepsy characterized by clusters of epileptic spasms, usually with a characteristic electroencephalogram pattern called hypsarrhythmia. Development may slow or regress; causes include brain injury, genetic conditions, and metabolic disease.

Alternate Names:
Infantile Epileptic Spasms Syndrome

Wet Age-Related Macular Degeneration

Alternate name; see *Wet Macular Degeneration*.

Wet AMD

Alternate name; see *Wet Macular Degeneration*.

Wet Beriberi

The predominantly cardiovascular form of severe thiamine deficiency. It can cause a fast heartbeat, enlarged or weakened heart, fluid retention, swelling, and high-output heart failure.

Wet Dream

Involuntary ejaculation during sleep, usually occurring in adolescence or adulthood and generally a normal physiological event.

Wet Gangrene

Tissue death with bacterial infection and swelling, producing moist, discolored, rapidly spreading necrosis. It can spread quickly and lead to sepsis.

Wet Macular Degeneration

The neovascular form of age-related macular degeneration in which abnormal blood vessels grow beneath or within the retina and leak fluid or blood, causing rapid central-vision loss.

Alternate Names:
Neovascular AMD; Exudative Age-Related Macular Degeneration; Wet AMD

Wet-to-Dry Dressing

A wound dressing in which moist gauze is allowed to dry and then removed to pull away attached tissue and debris. This is a nonselective form of mechanical debridement that can also remove healthy tissue and cause pain, so its use is limited.

Alternate Names:
Wet-to-Dry Debridement; Mechanical Gauze Dress-

ing

Wharton Duct

The primary excretory duct of the submandibular salivary gland, approximately 5 cm in length, that courses anteromedially along the floor of the mouth to empty through the sublingual caruncle at the base of the lingual frenulum; the most frequent anatomical site of salivary sialolithiasis.

Alternate Names:
Submandibular Duct

Wharton Jelly

The soft, jelly-like tissue surrounding the blood vessels in the umbilical cord. It cushions the vessels and helps prevent them from being squeezed or bent during pregnancy and labor.

Wharton's Jelly

Alternate spelling; see *Wharton Jelly*.

Wheal

A temporary, raised, often itchy area of skin caused by swelling in the skin. It commonly occurs with hives, an allergic reaction, or an insect bite and may move or disappear within hours.

Wheal And Flare

A temporary raised, swollen area of skin surrounded by redness. It is usually caused by release of histamine during hives, an allergy, or another immediate skin reaction.

Wheat Allergy

An immune reaction to proteins in wheat that may cause hives, stomach symptoms, vomiting, or breathing problems. It is distinct from celiac disease and non-celiac gluten sensitivity.

Alternate Names:
Wheat Hypersensitivity

Wheelchairs

Wheeled mobility devices that support a seated person and allow movement by manual propulsion or powered controls.

Wheeled Stretcher

Mobile patient transport device with wheels; used in hospitals and emergency services for moving patients who cannot walk.

Wheeze

A high-pitched whistling sound caused by narrowed airways. It often occurs with asthma, infection, allergy, or chronic lung disease; sudden wheezing after choking or with severe breathlessness can indicate acute airway obstruction.

Wheezing

A musical or whistling sound caused by narrowed lower airways, usually louder when breathing out. It may result from asthma, infection, chronic lung disease, allergy, airway swelling, mucus, or an inhaled object.

Whiplash

A neck injury caused by the head moving suddenly backward and forward, often in a vehicle crash but also after a fall or sports injury. Pain, stiffness, headache, dizziness, or arm tingling may appear immediately or later. Weakness, numbness, or difficulty walking can indicate nerve or spinal-cord injury; severe pain can accompany fracture.

Alternate Names:
Cervical Acceleration-Deceleration Injury; CAD Injury

Whiplash Injury

Alternate name; see *Whiplash*.

Whipple Disease

A rare, chronic bacterial infection caused by *Tropheryma whipplei* that primarily affects the digestive system, though it can involve any organ in the body. The bacteria damage the mucosal lining of the small intestine, impairing its ability to absorb nutrients and leading to severe diarrhea, abdominal cramps, and progressive weight loss. It often presents years earlier with migratory joint pain and arthritis, and can spread to the heart, eyes, and central nervous system.

Alternate Names:

Intestinal Lipodystrophy; Tropheryma Whipplei Infection

Whipple Procedure

A major operation that removes the head of the pancreas and nearby parts of the small intestine, bile duct, and gallbladder, then reconnects the digestive tract. It is used for selected cancers and other serious diseases in this area.

Whipple's Disease

Alternate name; see *Whipple Disease*.

Alternate Names:
Tropheryma Whipplei Infection; Whipple Disease

Whipple Triad

Three findings supporting that symptoms are caused by low blood sugar: typical symptoms occur, blood sugar is low at that time, and symptoms improve after blood sugar is raised.

Whipple Triad for Insulinoma

Alternate name; see *Whipple Triad*.

Whipple Triad of Hypoglycemia

Alternate name; see *Whipple Triad*.

Alternate Names:
Whipple Hypoglycemic Triad

Whipworm

A parasitic roundworm of the genus Trichuris, usually Trichuris trichiura in humans. Infection occurs by ingesting embryonated eggs and may cause abdominal pain, diarrhea, anemia, or rectal prolapse when severe.

Whipworm Infection

Intestinal infection caused by the soil-transmitted helminth Trichuris trichiura (whipworm), endemic in tropical and subtropical regions with poor sanitation. Humans acquire infection by ingesting embryonated eggs from contaminated soil, food, or water.

Alternate Names:
Trichuris Trichiura Infection; Whipworm Infection

Whirlpool Bath

Hydrotherapy device providing agitated water for therapeutic bathing; used in wound care, physical therapy, and rehabilitation.

Whispered Pectoriloquy

An examination finding in which whispered words sound unusually clear through a stethoscope over the lung. It may suggest that air-filled lung has become solid, as in pneumonia, but it is not diagnostic alone.

White Blood Cell

A cell of the immune system that helps protect the body from infections, foreign substances, and abnormal cells. White blood cells are made mainly in the bone marrow and include neutrophils, lymphocytes, monocytes, eosinophils, and basophils. Their number or function may change with infection, inflammation, immune disorders, or bone-marrow disease.

White Blood Cell Count

A blood test measuring the number of white blood cells. A high or low result can occur with infection, inflammation, medicines, immune disorders, or bone-marrow disease; the differential count describes the proportions of different white-cell types.

White Blood Cell Labeling

A scan method in which a person's white blood cells are removed, marked with a small amount of radioactive material, and returned to the body. The cells may collect at areas of infection or inflammation, which can then be seen on images.

White Cell

Alternate name; see *White Blood Cell*.

White Cell Count

Alternate name; see *White Blood Cell Count*.

White Clot Syndrome

A severe arterial or venous thrombotic complication associated with heparin-induced thrombocytopenia

(HIT). It is characterized by platelet-dense, fibrin-rich arterial thrombi (white thrombi) that can lead to limb ischemia, stroke, or myocardial infarction.

Alternate Names:
HIT-Associated Thrombosis; Heparin-Associated White Thrombus Syndrome

White Coat Hypertension

Blood pressure that is repeatedly high in a medical setting but normal outside it on home or ambulatory monitoring.

Alternate Names:
Isolated Clinic Hypertension

White-Coat Hypertension

Alternate spelling; see *White Coat Hypertension*.

Alternate Names:
White-Coat Syndrome

White Finger

Episodic pallor or whitening of the fingers caused by vasospasm, commonly associated with Raynaud phenomenon or hand-arm vibration syndrome.

Whiteheads

Alternate name; see *Closed Comedo*.

White Infarction

Tissue death caused by loss of blood flow in a solid organ such as the heart, kidney, or spleen. The damaged area looks pale because little blood can reach it through alternate vessels.

Alternate Names:
Anemic Infarction; Pale Infarction

White Matter

Tissue in the brain and spinal cord made mainly of nerve fibers covered by a protective substance called myelin. It carries signals between different brain areas and between the brain and spinal cord.

White Matter Hyperintensities

Areas in the brain's white matter that appear brighter than surrounding tissue on certain MRI sequences. They are common with aging and small-vessel disease but can have other causes, so their meaning depends on the pattern and clinical context.

Alternate Names:
WMHs; Leukoaraiosis

White Matter Of The Brain

Alternate name; see *White Matter*.

White (Milky) Urine

Alternate name; see *Milky Urine*.

White Nails

Alternate name; see *Leukonychia*.

White Of The Eye

The sclera, the tough, opaque outer coat of the eye surrounding the cornea and helping maintain the shape of the globe.

White Spot Disease

Older name for *lichen sclerosus*, a chronic inflammatory skin condition.

White Tongue

A white coating or patches on the tongue caused by debris, dry mouth, irritation, infection, inflammation, or other oral conditions.

White Urine

Alternate name; see *Milky Urine*.

Whitlow

An infection of the fingertip or tissues around a finger or toenail, often involving the nail fold. It is usually bacterial or caused by herpes simplex virus; grouped blisters suggest herpetic whitlow, whereas pus and a localized abscess suggest bacterial infection.

WHO Classification of Vitamin A Deficiency

A standardized clinical grading system established by the World Health Organization (WHO) to stage eye damage (xerophthalmia) caused by vitamin A

deficiency:

- **XN**: Night blindness (inability to see in dim light or darkness).
- **X1A**: Conjunctival xerosis (dryness and lack of shine on the white of the eye).
- **X1B**: Bitot's spots (foamy, silvery-white patches on the white of the eye).
- **X2**: Corneal xerosis (hazy, dry surface on the clear front of the eye).
- **X3A**: Corneal ulceration or keratomalacia involving less than one-third of the cornea.
- **X3B**: Corneal ulceration or keratomalacia involving one-third or more of the cornea, which can cause severe, lasting vision loss.
- **XS**: Corneal scars (permanent scarring left by healed ulcers).
- **XF**: Xerophthalmic fundus (small pale spots on the back of the eye/retina).

Alternate Names:
WHO Xerophthalmia Classification; Vitamin A Deficiency Eye Grading; WHO Vitamin A Staging

Whole-Body Irradiation

Radiation treatment directed at the entire body, most often given before a stem-cell transplant to suppress the immune system and make room for donated cells. It can affect the bone marrow, fertility, and other organs.

Whole-Body Magnetic Resonance Imaging

An MRI examination that produces images of much or all of the body without using X-rays. It is used in selected cases to look for widespread disease, tumors, or problems affecting several body areas.

Whole-Body Scan

An imaging examination that surveys much or all of the body, using a technique such as PET/CT, CT, MRI, or a nuclear medicine scan. It may be used for selected cancer staging, infection localization, or evaluation of systemic disease; the coverage and usefulness depend on the test and clinical question.

Whole Bowel Irrigation

A gastrointestinal decontamination technique in acute clinical toxicology in which large volumes of an isosmotic polyethylene glycol electrolyte solution are administered orally or via nasogastric tube until the rectal effluent is clear, indicated for toxic ingestions of sustained-release medications, enteric-coated tablets, iron, or illicit drug packets ("body packers").

Alternate Names:
WBI

Whole-Bowel Irrigation

Alternate spelling; see *Whole Bowel Irrigation*.

Whole-Brain Radiation Therapy

Radiation treatment directed at the entire brain, used in selected people with multiple brain metastases or cancer cells around the brain. It may also be used to reduce brain-spread risk in selected cancers; side effects depend on dose and treatment plan.

Whole Breast Radiation Therapy

Whole breast radiation therapy treats remaining breast tissue after breast-conserving surgery to reduce local recurrence risk, with planned dosing and monitoring for skin and tissue effects.

Whole Exome Sequencing

A genetic test that reads most protein-coding sections of a person's DNA. It can identify changes causing some inherited disorders but may miss changes outside coding regions, structural changes, or causes not yet understood; uncertain or incidental findings can complicate interpretation.

Whole Genome Sequencing

Laboratory analysis of nearly all of a person's nuclear DNA, including coding and noncoding regions, and sometimes mitochondrial DNA. It can identify many types of genetic variants but may produce uncertain or incidental findings and does not detect every cause of disease.

Whole-Genome Sequencing

Alternate spelling; see *Whole Genome Sequencing*.

Whooping Cough

A highly contagious respiratory infection caused by *Bordetella pertussis*. It causes prolonged bouts of rapid coughing that may be followed by a whooping sound or vomiting; infants may have pauses in breathing without the typical whoop. Also called pertussis.

Whooping-Cough

Alternate name; see *Whooping Cough*.

Whooping Cough (Pertussis)

Alternate name; see *Whooping Cough*.

Whorled Pattern

A characteristic histological or clinical swirling, spiraling architectural configuration. In pathology, it describes swirling arrangements of spindle cells seen in meningiomas, fibromas, or leiomyomas; in dermatology, it describes patterns along the lines of Blaschko.

Alternate Names:
Whorled Architecture; Storiform-Whorled Pattern

WHS

Abbreviation for Wolf-Hirschhorn syndrome, a rare chromosome 4 deletion disorder that may cause poor growth, distinctive facial features, developmental disability, seizures, and congenital abnormalities.

Wickham Striae

Fine, lacy white reticular lines and arborizing patterns seen on the surface of papules and mucosal plaques in lichen planus, classically observed on the buccal mucosa.

Widal Reaction

An older blood test for antibodies associated with typhoid or paratyphoid fever. It is not very reliable because results may reflect past infection or vaccination, so culture or molecular testing is usually preferred.

Widal Test

Alternate name; see *Widal Reaction*.

Widely Spaced Teeth

Teeth separated by unusually large gaps, also called diastema when the gap is localized. Causes include normal development, missing teeth, tooth-size differences, habits, or jaw and gum conditions.

Widened Mediastinum

An increased width of the central chest area on an imaging study, especially a chest X-ray. It can result from positioning or technique, but may also reflect bleeding, aortic disease, a mass, or other conditions.

Alternate Names:
Mediastinal Widening; Mediastinal Enlargement

Widened Pulse Pressure

An unusually large difference between systolic and diastolic blood pressure. It may occur with aging, aortic valve leakage, thyroid disease, fever, or other conditions; interpretation depends on age and clinical context.

Wide Splitting of S2

An abnormal prolongation of the interval between the aortic (A2) and pulmonic (P2) components of the second heart sound that varies physiologically with respiration but remains distinctly separated in expiration. It occurs due to delayed right ventricular emptying (such as right bundle branch block or pulmonary stenosis) or early aortic valve closure.

Wilkie Syndrome

Vascular compression of the third (horizontal) segment of the duodenum between the abdominal aorta and the overlying superior mesenteric artery (SMA). It leads to partial or complete duodenal obstruction, characterized by postprandial abdominal pain, early satiety, nausea, and vomiting.

Alternate Names:
Superior Mesenteric Artery Syndrome; SMA Syndrome; Arteriomesenteric Duodenal Compression

Williams-Beuren Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Williams Syndrome*.

Williams Syndrome

A genetic condition caused by loss of a small section of chromosome 7, including a gene important for elastic tissues. It may cause characteristic facial features, heart-vessel narrowing, high blood calcium, developmental differences, learning difficulties, and connective-tissue problems. Regular heart, calcium, hearing, and developmental checks are important.

Willis-Ekbom Disease

Another name for restless legs syndrome, a neurologic sleep-related movement disorder causing an urge to move the legs and uncomfortable sensations that worsen at rest and at night.

Wilms Tumor

A rare type of kidney cancer that primarily affects young children, most commonly diagnosed between the ages of 2 and 5. It arises from immature kidney cells that fail to develop into mature tissue before birth, eventually forming a large mass within one or, rarely, both kidneys. The most common early sign is a painless, firm swelling or lump in the child's abdomen, which may be accompanied by blood in the urine, fever, abdominal discomfort, or elevated blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Nephroblastoma; Embryonal Nephroma

Wilm's Tumour

Common misspelling; see *Wilms Tumor*.

Wilson Disease

A rare inherited genetic disorder in which the body cannot properly eliminate excess copper, causing toxic levels of copper to accumulate in vital organs. While copper is an essential dietary trace mineral, individuals with this condition cannot excrete it into bile, so copper gradually builds up in the liver, brain, eyes, and kidneys. Symptoms typically begin in childhood or early adulthood and include liver damage (hepatitis or cirrhosis), neurological problems (tremors, clumsiness, speech difficulties), psychiatric changes, and characteristic copper-colored rings around the outer edge of the eye's cornea (Kayser-Fleischer rings).

Alternate Names:
Hepatolenticular Degeneration; Copper Storage Disease

Wilson's Disease

Alternate name; see *Wilson Disease*.

Winchester Syndrome

A very rare inherited skeletal dysplasia with progressive osteolysis, short stature, joint contractures, and characteristic facial or skin findings.

Windkessel Effect

The hemodynamic property of large elastic arteries, particularly the aorta, which expand during ventricular systole to store a portion of stroke volume and recoil during diastole. This elastic recoil sustains downstream blood flow and maintains organ perfusion throughout diastole.

Alternate Names:
Windkessel Function; Arterial Elastic Reservoir Effect

Windowing

Adjusting the brightness and contrast of a CT image so particular tissues, such as bone, lung, or soft tissue, are easier to see.

Windpipe

The tube carrying air from the voice box to the two main airways leading to the lungs. It is supported by firm rings that help keep it open.

Winged Scapula

An abnormal musculoskeletal prominence of the medial border and inferior angle of the scapula protruding posteriorly from the thoracic cage, most commonly caused by traction injury, surgical damage, or neuropathy of the long thoracic nerve of Bell paralyzing the serratus anterior muscle.

Alternate Names:
Scapula Alata

Winterbottom Sign

Prominent enlargement of the posterior cervical lymph nodes that serves as a classic clinical physical sign of early-stage African trypanosomiasis (sleeping sickness), caused by Trypanosoma brucei.

Alternate Names:
Winterbottom's Sign

Winter Formula

A formula for estimating the expected $PaCO_2$ in metabolic acidosis: $1.5 \times [HCO_3^-] + 8 \pm 2$ mm Hg. A measured value above the expected range suggests concurrent respiratory acidosis; a value below it suggests concurrent respiratory alkalosis.

Alternate Names:
Winter's Compensation Formula; Acid-Base Compensation Equation

Winter's Formula

Alternate name; see *Winter Formula*.

Alternate Names:
Winter Formula; Metabolic Acidosis Compensation Formula

Winter Vomiting Disease

An acute gastroenteritis, usually caused by norovirus, characterized by sudden vomiting, diarrhea, and abdominal cramps.

Wireless Motility Capsule

A swallowed capsule that records pressure, acidity, temperature, and movement as it travels through the digestive tract. The measurements estimate how long food takes to pass through the stomach and intestines and may help investigate unexplained constipation, diarrhea, nausea, or bloating.

Wirsung Duct

The main excretory duct of the pancreas, extending from the tail through the body and head of the gland, joining the common bile duct at the hepatopancreatic ampulla of Vater to empty digestive enzymes into the second part of the duodenum at the major duodenal papilla.

Alternate Names:
Main Pancreatic Duct

Wisdom Teeth

Plural form; see *Wisdom Tooth*.

Wisdom Tooth

The third molar in each dental quadrant (four in total: upper and lower left and right), representing the last teeth to erupt in the permanent human dentition, typically between ages 17 and 25. Due to evolutionary reduction in human jaw size, wisdom teeth frequently undergo partial or complete impaction (mesioangular, horizontal, vertical, or distoangular). Pathological sequelae of impacted wisdom teeth include acute or chronic pericoronitis (inflammation and infection of the operculum overlying the partially erupted crown), odontogenic abscesses, root resorption or dental caries on the distal aspect of the adjacent second molar, and the development of dentigerous cysts or odontogenic tumors (e.g., ameloblastoma). Prophylactic or therapeutic surgical odontectomy (extraction) is commonly indicated, carefully planned with panoramic radiography or cone-beam CT to assess spatial proximity to the inferior alveolar nerve and maxillary sinus.

Alternate Names:
Dens Serotinus; Third Molar

Wisdom Tooth Problems

Problems involving third molars, including impaction, infection, gum inflammation, decay, cysts, or damage to nearby teeth. Findings can include pain, swelling, fever, difficulty opening the mouth, or trouble swallowing.

Wisdom Tooth Removal

Dental extraction of one or more third molars, commonly performed when they are impacted, repeatedly infected, decayed, or damaging adjacent teeth. Risks include pain, infection, bleeding, dry socket, and temporary or rarely persistent nerve symptoms.

Wiskott-Aldrich Syndrome

A rare inherited immune disorder that mainly affects boys and causes eczema, repeated infections, and a

low number of unusually small platelets. It can also cause bleeding, autoimmune disease, and increased cancer risk.

Wiskott-Aldrich Syndrome Protein

A protein, encoded by the *WAS* gene, that helps immune and blood cells organize their internal support structure and interact with other cells. Changes in the gene can cause Wiskott-Aldrich syndrome or related platelet disorders.

Alternate Names:
WASP

Witch's Milk

A temporary milky breast discharge in a newborn caused by exposure to maternal hormones before birth. It usually resolves as those hormones decline.

Withdrawal

Physical or psychological symptoms that occur when a person who has developed dependence reduces or stops using a medicine or psychoactive substance. Symptoms vary by substance and may include anxiety, agitation, sweating, tremor, nausea, pain, insomnia, cravings, or seizures; withdrawal from alcohol or sedatives can be life-threatening.

Alternate Names:
Abstinence Syndrome; Substance Withdrawal Syndrome

Withdrawal Reflex

An automatic response in which a painful stimulus makes a limb pull away from danger. The opposite limb may straighten to help maintain balance.

Withdrawal Symptoms

Physical or psychological symptoms that occur when a person stops or reduces a substance or medicine after the body has adapted to it. The symptoms depend on the substance, duration of use, and the person's health.

Withdrawal Syndrome

A predictable set of signs and symptoms that occur when a drug is discontinued or the dose is reduced after chronic use, reflecting the physiological rebound from drug adaptation.

Withdrawal Syndromes

Alternate name; see *Withdrawal Syndrome*.

With-the-rule Astigmatism

A type of astigmatism in which the eye's steepest curve is close to vertical. This uneven shape makes light focus unevenly on the retina and can blur or distort vision. It is the opposite of against-the-rule astigmatism.

Wolff-Chaikoff Effect

A temporary reduction in thyroid hormone production that can occur after a large increase in iodine exposure. The thyroid often adapts after several days and hormone production resumes; the response varies by person and condition.

Alternate Names:
Wolff-Chaikoff Block; Iodide Organification Inhibition

Wolffian Ducts

Temporary tubes in the developing embryo that form parts of the male reproductive system, including the sperm-transport ducts. They usually shrink during typical female development, although small remnants may remain.

Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome

A congenital heart condition characterized by the presence of an extra, abnormal electrical pathway connecting the upper and lower chambers of the heart. This extra electrical pathway acts like an electrical short-circuit, allowing electrical signals to bypass the heart's natural gatekeeper (the atrioventricular node) and reach the ventricles prematurely. This can trigger sudden episodes of dangerously fast heartbeats (paroxysmal tachycardia), causing palpitations, dizziness, shortness of breath, and fainting.

Alternate Names:
WPW Syndrome; Ventricular Pre-Excitation Syndrome

Wolff-Parkinson-White Tachycardia

Alternate name; see *Wolff-Parkinson-White Syndrome*.

Wolf Hirschhorn Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see *Wolf-Hirschhorn Syndrome*.

Wolf-Hirschhorn Syndrome

A rare genetic disorder caused by loss of part of chromosome 4. It can cause poor growth, a small head, distinctive facial features, developmental and intellectual disability, seizures, and heart or other organ abnormalities.

Alternate Names:
4p- Syndrome; 4p Deletion Syndrome

Wolfram Syndrome

A rare inherited disorder that commonly causes diabetes mellitus and progressive loss of vision from optic-nerve damage. It may also cause excessive thirst and urination, hearing loss, bladder problems, balance difficulty, or other nervous-system problems.

Wolf Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Wolf-Hirschhorn Syndrome*.

Wolinella

Genus of anaerobic, Gram-negative bacteria found in the oral cavity and gastrointestinal tract; associated with periodontal disease.

Wolman Disease

The severe infantile form of lysosomal acid lipase deficiency, an inherited disorder that causes cholesteryl esters and triglycerides to build up in organs. It can cause vomiting, diarrhea, poor growth, an enlarged liver and spleen, and adrenal-gland calcification; without treatment it is often fatal in infancy.

Wolman's Disease

Alternate name; see *Wolman Disease*.

Womb

Common name for the uterus; the muscular organ where a fetus develops during pregnancy.

Alternate Names:
Uterus; Metra; Hystera

Womb Growths

Alternate name; see *Uterine Fibroids*.

Women Health

Alternate name; see *Women's Health*.

Women's Health

An area of health care addressing physical, mental, and reproductive health needs across the lifespan. It includes conditions that affect women uniquely, more often, or differently, and encompasses prevention, diagnosis, and treatment across medical specialties. It extends beyond obstetric and gynecologic care.

Alternate Names:
Female Health Care

Wood Lamp Examination

Examination of the skin in a dark room with ultraviolet A light. Fluorescence or color changes can help identify selected skin conditions, but findings are interpreted with the clinical examination.

Woods Corkscrew Maneuver

An emergency procedure used when a baby's shoulders become stuck during birth. A trained clinician rotates the baby's shoulders to help release them and complete delivery.

Wood's Light

Alternate name; see *Wood Lamp Examination*.

Wood Spirit

An old name for methanol, a toxic alcohol whose ingestion can cause metabolic acidosis, blindness, and death.

Woods Screw Maneuver

Alternate name; see *Woods Corkscrew Maneuver*.

Wood-Unit

A clinical unit of vascular resistance calculated by

dividing the pressure gradient across a vascular bed (in mmHg) by cardiac output (in L/min). One Wood unit equals approximately 80 dyn·s/cm^5, commonly used in evaluating pulmonary hypertension.

Alternate Names:
Wood Resistance Unit; Hybrid Resistance Unit (HRU)

Woody Tongue

A rare long-lasting infection, usually caused by *Actinomyces*, that makes the tongue and nearby tissues hard and swollen. It can interfere with eating, speaking, or breathing.

Woolly Hair

Hair with unusually tight, fine curls. It may be an inherited trait occurring on its own or as part of a condition affecting other organs, such as Naxos or Carvajal syndrome.

Alternate Names:
Woolly Hair Syndrome; Hereditary Woolly Hair

Woolsorters' Disease

A form of inhaled anthrax acquired by breathing spores of *Bacillus anthracis*, historically associated with handling contaminated wool or animal products. It can cause severe respiratory illness, sepsis, and shock.

Alternate Names:
Inhalation Anthrax; Pulmonary Anthrax; Ragpicker's Disease

Word Blindness

Older term; see *Alexia*.

Word Deafness

An acquired inability to understand spoken words even though ordinary hearing is intact. It usually results from damage to brain areas that connect hearing with language, such as after a stroke or head injury.

Alternate Names:
Pure Word Deafness; Auditory Agnosia for Speech

Word Recognition Scoring

A hearing test measuring how accurately a person repeats or identifies spoken words at a comfortable volume. It helps assess how well the hearing system and brain understand speech.

Word Salad

Speech made of words or phrases that have little or no logical connection, making the person difficult to understand. It can occur with severe psychosis, mania, brain disease, or intoxication.

Working Memory

The ability to hold a small amount of information briefly and use it while completing a task, such as remembering instructions while following them. Attention, stress, sleep, illness, and brain conditions can affect it.

Wound

Damage to body tissue caused by trauma, surgery, pressure, heat, chemicals, or another cause. A wound may be open or closed and can vary in depth, contamination, bleeding, and injury to nearby nerves, vessels, or organs.

Wound Care

Assessment and treatment of a wound through cleansing, bleeding control, debridement when indicated, closure or dressing, pain control, and follow-up. It may also address infection, pressure, tetanus risk, and underlying conditions.

Wound Classification

A description of common injury types: an abrasion is a scrape, a laceration is a torn cut, a contusion is a bruise from blunt force, and an incised wound is a clean cut from a sharp object.

Wound Complication

A problem that develops during healing, such as infection, separation of wound edges, bleeding, fluid collection, tissue death, or excessive scarring. Findings can include increasing pain, redness, swelling, drainage, fever, or wound opening.

Wound Closure

The clinical approximation and securing of the edges of an open wound or surgical incision using sutures, surgical staples, skin adhesive, or adhesive strips; see *Suture*.

Wound Debridement

Removal of dead tissue, debris, or foreign material from a wound. It may be done with instruments, dressings, enzymes, or other methods to support wound assessment and healing.

Wound Dehiscence

Partial or complete reopening of a surgical wound after it has been closed. It may follow infection, poor blood supply, diabetes, increased pressure, or strain on the wound. Associated findings include drainage, fever, severe pain, or visible deeper tissue.

Wound Evisceration

Separation of a surgical wound with protrusion of internal organs or tissue through the opening. It is a surgical emergency because exposed tissue is vulnerable to injury, drying, and contamination.

Wound Healing

The body's process of stopping bleeding, controlling inflammation, replacing damaged tissue, covering the surface, and strengthening the repair. Blood supply, infection, nutrition, diabetes, medicines, smoking, wound depth, and movement can affect healing.

Wound Healing Phases

Wound healing has overlapping stages: stopping bleeding, inflammation, building new tissue and skin, and strengthening the repair. The timing and result depend on the wound, blood supply, infection, nutrition, and general health.

Wound Infection

Infection of a wound by microorganisms, causing findings such as increasing pain, redness, warmth, swelling, pus, fever, or delayed healing.

Wound Management

Assessment and treatment of acute or chronic wounds through cleansing, debridement when indicated, moisture and exudate control, infection management, pressure relief, nutrition, and correction of underlying disease.

Wounds

Alternate name; see *Wound*.

Wound VAC

A system that applies controlled negative pressure through a sealed wound dressing to remove fluid. It is used for selected wounds to support healing.

Wound Vacuum

Alternate name; see *Wound VAC*.

Alternate Names:
Negative Pressure Wound Therapy; NPWT; Vacuum-Assisted Closure; VAC

WPW Syndrome

Abbreviation for Wolff-Parkinson-White syndrome, a pre-excitation disorder in which an extra electrical pathway can cause episodes of supraventricular tachycardia. Manifestations include palpitations, fainting, chest pain, or, rarely, sudden cardiac arrest.

Wright Hyperabduction Test

Alternate name; see *Wright Test*.

Alternate Names:
Wright Test; Hyperabduction Maneuver

Wright Stain

A laboratory dye applied to a blood sample so different blood cells and abnormal cell changes can be seen and identified under a microscope.

Wright Test

A physical examination maneuver in which the arm is raised and rotated outward to see whether this reproduces symptoms or changes the pulse. It may be used when assessing thoracic outlet syndrome, but a pulse change alone does not establish the

diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Wright Maneuver; Hyperabduction Test

Wrinkle Test

A simple clinical bedside test to evaluate peripheral sympathetic autonomic nerve function in the digits. Denervated skin fails to develop normal physiological wrinkling when submerged in warm water for 10 to 30 minutes, indicating loss of sympathetic vasoconstrictor tone.

Alternate Names:
Digital Wrinkling Test; Water Immersion Wrinkle Test

Wrisberg Ganglion

A small cluster of nerve cells connected with the facial nerve. It helps relay taste signals from part of the tongue and sensory signals from nearby areas of the ear.

Wrist

The region connecting the hand to the forearm. It includes eight small carpal bones, joints, ligaments, tendons, nerves, and blood vessels and allows the hand to bend, straighten, and move from side to side.

Wrist Arthroscopy

A procedure using a small camera and instruments inserted through tiny wrist openings to examine or treat damaged cartilage, ligaments, joint lining, or other wrist problems.

Wrist Drop

Inability to lift the wrist and fingers, usually caused by injury or compression of the radial nerve. It may occur with weakness, numbness, or difficulty using the hand.

Wrist Fracture

A break in one or more bones near the wrist, most commonly the distal radius or ulna, usually caused by a fall, direct trauma, or weakened bone.

Wrist Injury

Damage to the bones, ligaments, tendons, nerves, or vessels of the wrist from a fall, twist, impact, or overuse. Injuries range from sprains to fractures, instability, or neurovascular damage.

Wrist Joint

The group of joints connecting the forearm to the hand. It allows the wrist to bend, straighten, and move from side to side; rotation of the forearm occurs mainly at the radioulnar joints.

Wrist Pain

Pain in or around the wrist, commonly caused by sprain, fracture, tendinitis, arthritis, or nerve compression such as carpal tunnel syndrome. Persistent pain may occur with deformity, numbness, or weakness.

Alternate Names:
Carpal Pain; Radiocarpal Joint Discomfort

Wrist Sprain

Stretching or tearing of one or more ligaments supporting the wrist, causing pain, swelling, bruising, and reduced movement after injury.

Writer's Cramp

A task-specific focal dystonia in which involuntary muscle contractions cause abnormal hand or arm positions while writing. Similar symptoms may occur during other skilled hand activities.

Wry-Neck

Torticollis, an abnormal tilt or rotation of the head caused by involuntary contraction, shortening, or dysfunction of neck muscles.

Wt

A medical abbreviation commonly meaning weight; its meaning can vary with context because medical abbreviations may be ambiguous.

Wuchereria

A genus of filarial nematodes that includes Wuchereria bancrofti, a major cause of lymphatic filariasis.

Infection is transmitted by mosquitoes and may cause lymphangitis, chronic lymphedema, hydrocele, and elephantiasis.

Wuchereria Bancrofti

A parasitic roundworm spread by mosquitoes and the main cause of lymphatic filariasis. Long-term infection can block lymph drainage and cause swelling of the limbs or genitals, sometimes becoming severe and permanent.

Wuhan Coronavirus

Informal early name; see *SARS-CoV-2*.

X

Xanthelasma

A harmless yellowish patch or bump caused by fat deposits in the skin of the eyelids, usually near the inner corners of the eyes. It can occur with high blood fats but may also occur when blood-fat levels are normal.

Alternate Names:
Xanthelasma Palpebrarum; Eyelid Xanthoma; Palpebral Xanthoma

Xanthine

A purine breakdown product and an intermediate in uric-acid production. The enzyme xanthine oxidoreductase converts it to uric acid; when this step is impaired, xanthine can build up and form urinary stones.

Xanthine Oxidase

An enzyme in purine breakdown that converts hypoxanthine to xanthine and xanthine to uric acid. Medicines that block it lower uric-acid production and are used to treat gout and some cases of high uric acid.

Xanthine Oxidase Inhibitors

Medicines such as allopurinol and febuxostat that lower uric-acid production by blocking xanthine oxidase. They are used to lower uric acid in gout and in some cases of high uric acid associated with cancer treatment.

Alternate Names:
XOIs

Xanthinuria

A rare inherited disorder in which reduced xanthine oxidoreductase activity impairs the conversion of hypoxanthine and xanthine to uric acid. Uric-acid levels in blood and urine are very low; excess xanthine can form kidney or urinary stones, though some people have no symptoms.

Xanthochromia

A pink, yellow, or amber discoloration of the fluid surrounding the brain and spinal cord (cerebrospinal fluid) observed after centrifugation. It occurs when red blood cells that have leaked into the spinal fluid break down over several hours into yellow-tinted pigments, such as bilirubin. Its presence is a crucial diagnostic indicator that helps doctors confirm a subarachnoid hemorrhage (bleeding around the brain) and distinguish it from accidental minor bleeding caused by the spinal tap needle itself.

Alternate Names:
CSF Xanthochromia; Cerebrospinal Fluid Xanthochromia

Xanthogranulomatous

Describing inflammation in which tissue contains many immune cells filled with fat. This pattern can occur in long-lasting infections and other inflammatory conditions.

Xanthogranulomatous Cholecystitis

A rare, long-lasting inflammation of the gallbladder that can thicken and damage its wall. It may spread to nearby tissues and can look like gallbladder cancer on scans.

Alternate Names:
XGC

Xanthogranulomatous Oophoritis

A rare, chronic inflammation of an ovary that can form a mass resembling ovarian cancer on imaging. Reported associations include infection and endometriosis; symptoms may include pelvic pain, fever, or abnormal bleeding.

Xanthogranulomatous Pyelonephritis

A chronic, destructive inflammation of the kidney, usually associated with urinary blockage, stones, and infection. It replaces normal kidney tissue with inflamed tissue and may form a mass that resembles a tumor.

Xanthoma

A skin condition characterized by the formation of yellowish, fatty growths or nodules beneath the skin, caused by the localized accumulation of lipid-laden immune cells (macrophages). Xanthomas often develop when blood levels of cholesterol or triglycerides are abnormally high, which can occur from inherited lipid disorders, poorly controlled diabetes, or liver disease. They commonly appear on or around the eyelids (xanthelasma), over the elbows, knees, buttocks, or along tendons such as the Achilles tendon.

Alternate Names:
Cutaneous Xanthoma; Lipid Granuloma

Xanthoma Disseminatum

A rare disorder in which many yellow, red-brown, or orange bumps develop on the skin, especially in body folds. The mouth, throat, or other organs may also be affected, and some people develop problems controlling water balance.

Alternate Names:
Montgomery Syndrome; Disseminate Xanthoma

Xanthoma Eruptivum

A sudden outbreak of many small yellow-orange bumps, usually on the buttocks, arms, legs, or shoulders. It is often linked to very high blood triglyceride levels.

Alternate Names:
Eruptive Xanthoma; Eruptive Xanthomatosis

Xanthoma Planum

Flat or slightly raised yellow patches caused by lipid-filled immune cells in the skin. They may occur in skin folds or over wider areas and can be associated with abnormal blood lipids or some blood disorders. Palmar crease xanthomas are a distinct pattern.

Alternate Names:
Plane Xanthoma

Xanthomas

See *Xanthoma*.

Xanthoma Striatum Palmare

Yellow or orange lines or patches in the creases of the palms caused by fat deposits in the skin. They are strongly associated with inherited blood-fat disorders, especially type III dysbetalipoproteinemia.

Alternate Names:
Palmar Crease Xanthoma; Planar Palmar Xanthoma

Xanthoma Tendinosum

Firm, usually painless fat deposits in tendons or ligaments, most often in the Achilles tendon or tendons of the hands. They are strongly linked to inherited high cholesterol.

Alternate Names:
Tendon Xanthoma; Tendinous Xanthoma

Xanthomatosis

A disorder in which fatty deposits called xanthomas develop in the skin, tendons, or organs. It may be linked to inherited or acquired problems with blood fats.

Xanthoma Tuberosum

Slowly enlarging, painless, firm, yellowish-red nodular lipid deposits occurring over extensor pressure areas, particularly the elbows, knees, heels, and buttocks. They are strongly associated with familial hypercholesterolemia and type III hyperlipoproteinemia.

Alternate Names:
Tuberous Xanthoma; Tuberous Xanthomatosis

Xanthopsia

A visual disturbance in which objects appear yellow or yellow-tinted. It can occur with retinal or optic-nerve disorders and with toxicity from some medicines, including digoxin.

Xanthosis

Yellow discoloration of skin or other tissues caused by carotene or another yellow substance. Unlike jaundice, it does not usually make the whites of the eyes yellow; causes include dietary pigments and some systemic conditions.

X Chromosome

One of the two human sex chromosomes. It carries genes involved in sex development and many other body functions. Most people have one or two X chromosomes, although chromosome patterns vary.

Xenobiotic

A chemical foreign to an organism, such as a medicine, pollutant, pesticide, or industrial compound. The body may change or remove it; the original chemical or its products can have biological effects.

Xenobiotic Metabolism

The body's chemical processing of foreign substances, including medicines, pollutants, and toxins. Enzymes, especially in the liver, may make them easier to eliminate, alter their activity, or produce harmful products.

Xenobiotic Resistance

The ability of a cell or organism to withstand a foreign chemical, medicine, or toxin. It may result from faster breakdown, removal from cells, or changes in the substance's target.

Alternate Names:
Xenobiotic Tolerance

Xenograft

Tissue, cells, or a biological material transplanted between different species, such as animal tissue used in a human. Rejection and infection are important risks, although some materials are used temporarily as tissue coverings or substitutes.

Xenon Anesthesia

General anesthesia produced by inhaled xenon, a noble gas that acts on brain signaling. The gas is eliminated mainly through the lungs; its clinical use is limited by cost and availability.

Xenotransplantation

Transplantation of living cells, tissues, or organs from one species to another, usually from a nonhuman animal into a person. The recipient's immune system may reject the graft, and animal infections may be transmitted. In regulatory definitions, the term also includes transplanting, implanting, or infusing human cells, tissues, or body fluids that contacted living nonhuman animal material outside the body.

Xerochilia

Persistent dryness and scaling of the lips, sometimes with superficial cracks. Causes include dry weather, repeated lip licking, mouth breathing, and medicines such as oral retinoids.

Alternate Names:
Dry Lips

Xeroderma

Alternate name; see *Dry Skin*.

Xeroderma Pigmentosum

A rare inherited genetic condition in which the body's cells cannot repair the DNA damage caused by ultraviolet (UV) light, such as sunlight. Even minimal sun exposure causes severe sunburns, blistering, and heavy freckling at an early age. Because damaged DNA accumulates without repair, individuals have an extremely high risk of developing multiple skin cancers, severe eye damage, and, in some cases, progressive neurological complications.

Alternate Names:
XP; DeSanctis-Cacchione Syndrome (in neurodegenerative subtypes)

Xeroderma Pigmentosum

Complementation Groups

Genetic subtypes of xeroderma pigmentosum, each associated with a different gene involved in nucleotide-excision repair or DNA damage tolerance. The subtype helps explain the molecular cause; all types increase sensitivity to ultraviolet radiation and the risk of skin cancer.

Alternate Names:
XP Complementation Groups; NER Defect Groups

Xerophthalmia

The spectrum of eye disease caused by vitamin A deficiency, ranging from night blindness and dryness of the conjunctiva or cornea to corneal ulceration and keratomalacia, the softening and destruction of corneal tissue. Advanced disease can scar the cornea and cause permanent vision loss.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin A Deficiency Eye Disease

Xerophthalmic Ulceration

Corneal ulceration caused by severe vitamin A deficiency, sometimes progressing to keratomalacia (softening and destruction of the cornea). In the WHO classification, stage X3A affects less than one-third of the cornea and X3B affects at least one-third; scarring and vision loss can result.

Alternate Names:
Vitamin A Corneal Ulcer

Xerosis

Alternate name; see *Dry Skin*.

Xerostomia

Alternate name; see *Dry Mouth*.

Xerotic Eczema

An itchy form of eczema caused by very dry skin, with scaling and fine cracks that may form a netlike pattern. It often affects the lower legs and is more common in cold, dry weather and in older adults.

Alternate Names:
Asteatotic Eczema; Eczema Craquele; Winter Itch

X-Inactivation

The process by which most genes on one X chromosome are switched off in each cell with more than one X chromosome. It balances X-linked gene activity; some genes escape inactivation, and the chromosome switched off can differ among cells.

Xiphisternal Joint

The joint between the lower part of the breastbone and the xiphoid process. It often becomes partly or fully hardened with age.

Alternate Names:
Xiphisternal Synchondrosis; Xiphisternal Articulation

Xiphoidalgia

Pain or tenderness over the xiphoid process, the small lower part of the breastbone. Pain may spread to the upper abdomen, chest, back, or shoulders and may worsen with touch, bending, lifting, or coughing.

Alternate Names:
Xiphoidodynia; Hypersensitive Xiphoid Syndrome; Xiphoid Syndrome

Xiphoidectomy

Surgery to remove the xiphoid process, the small lower part of the breastbone. It may be done for persistent pain in this area or to provide access during some chest or abdominal operations.

Xiphoid Process

The small pointed lower part of the breastbone. Its shape varies between people and it provides attachment for some muscles and ligaments.

X-Linked

Describing a gene or condition involving a gene on the X chromosome. Its inheritance and effects depend on the gene and a person's sex-chromosome pattern. A father passes his X chromosome to children who inherit his X, not to children who inherit his Y.

X-Linked Adrenoleukodystrophy

An inherited disorder in which very-long-chain fatty acids build up and can damage the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, or adrenal glands. Childhood cerebral disease may cause changes in behavior, learning, or movement; adrenal insufficiency and adult-onset nerve or spinal-cord disease also occur.

Alternate Names:
X-ALD

X-linked Adult Spinal Muscular Atrophy

An older name for X-linked spinal and bulbar muscular atrophy (Kennedy disease), an inherited androgen-receptor disorder. It usually begins in adulthood and causes slowly progressive muscle weakness, wasting, and twitching; swallowing difficulty, breast enlargement, and reduced fertility may occur.

X-Linked Agammaglobulinemia

A rare inherited immune disorder affecting males in which the body is unable to produce mature B cells, the specialized white blood cells responsible for making antibodies (immunoglobulins). While maternal antibodies protect the baby for the first several months of life, their decline leaves the child vulnerable to recurrent, severe bacterial infections—such as ear infections, pneumonia, sinusitis, and gastrointestinal infections.

Alternate Names:
XLA; Bruton Agammaglobulinemia; Congenital Agammaglobulinemia

X-Linked Chronic Granulomatous Disease

An inherited immune disorder, usually affecting boys, caused by a change in the *CYBB* gene. Certain white blood cells cannot kill some bacteria and fungi normally, leading to repeated serious infections and areas of ongoing inflammation.

Alternate Names:
X-Linked CGD; CYBB Deficiency; Cytochrome b-245 Beta Deficiency

X-Linked Dominant Inheritance

An inheritance pattern in which a variant in one copy of a gene on the X chromosome can cause a condition. An affected father passes the variant to all daughters and no sons; an affected mother has a 50% chance of passing it to each child.

X-Linked Emery-Dreifuss Muscular Dystrophy

An inherited muscle disorder, usually caused by a variant in the *EMD* gene, that causes joint contractures, slowly worsening muscle weakness, and heart-conduction problems.

Alternate Names:
EDMD1; Emerin Deficiency Muscular Dystrophy

X-Linked Hyper-IgM Syndrome

An inherited immune disorder, usually caused by a defect in CD40 ligand on T cells. This impairs B-cell antibody class switching, so IgM is present but other antibody types are low; recurrent infections may include opportunistic infections.

Alternate Names:
HIGM1; CD40L Deficiency; Hyper-IgM Syndrome Type 1

X-Linked Hypophosphatemia

An inherited disorder, usually caused by a variant in the *PHEX* gene, in which the kidneys lose too much phosphate. Low phosphate impairs bone mineralization, causing rickets in children or osteomalacia in adults, with bone pain, leg deformity, dental problems, or reduced height.

X-Linked Ichthyosis

An inherited skin disorder caused by deficient steroid sulfatase, usually due to a variant or deletion in the *STS* gene. It mainly affects males and causes widespread, dark, polygonal scales, often from infancy.

X-Linked Inheritance

Inheritance of a gene variant located on the X chromosome. The pattern and effects depend on the gene, the variant, and the person's sex-chromosome pattern. A father passes his X chromosome only to children who inherit his X, not to those who inherit his Y.

X-linked Intellectual Disability

Intellectual disability caused by a change in a gene on the X chromosome. Features vary widely and may include developmental delay, learning difficulty, behavior differences, seizures, or associated physical findings.

X-linked Juvenile Retinoschisis

An older name for X-linked retinoschisis, an inherited retinal disorder that usually begins in childhood.

X-Linked Lymphoproliferative Disease Type 1

An inherited immune disorder, usually affecting boys, in which the body can react severely to Epstein–Barr virus. It may cause severe glandular fever, very high inflammation, low antibody levels, or lymphoma.

Alternate Names:
XLP1; Duncan Disease; SAP Deficiency

X-Linked Lymphoproliferative Syndrome

A group of inherited immune disorders in which infection, especially with Epstein–Barr virus, can trigger an abnormal immune response, including severe inflammation, low blood-cell counts, or lymphoma. Type 1 is caused by *SH2D1A* variants; type 2 is caused by *XIAP* variants.

X-Linked Myotubular Myopathy

A rare inherited muscle disease, usually affecting boys, that causes severe weakness and low muscle tone from birth. Babies may have drooping eyelids, feeding difficulty, and dangerous weakness of the breathing muscles.

Alternate Names:
XLMTM; Myotubularin Deficiency

X-Linked Recessive Inheritance

A pattern in which a disease-causing variant on the X chromosome usually causes disease in people with one X chromosome. People with two X chromosomes may carry one variant copy and sometimes have symptoms. A father passes his X chromosome only to children who inherit his X, not to those who inherit his Y.

X-Linked Retinitis Pigmentosa

An inherited disorder in which the retina slowly loses its ability to sense light. It usually causes night blindness followed by narrowing of the field of vision and worsening sight.

Alternate Names:
XLRP; X-Linked Pigmentary Retinopathy

X-Linked Retinoschisis

An inherited retinal disorder, usually caused by a variant in the *RS1* gene, in which layers of the retina split apart. It usually begins in childhood and causes reduced central vision; bleeding into the eye or retinal detachment can occur.

X-Linked Severe Combined Immunodeficiency

A rare, life-threatening inherited genetic disorder of the immune system that occurs almost exclusively in males. A mutation on the X chromosome impairs the development of vital white blood cells—particularly T cells and natural killer (NK) cells—leaving the infant with virtually no immune defenses. Affected infants appear healthy at birth but quickly develop recurrent, severe, and persistent infections from common viruses, bacteria, and fungi, as well as chronic diarrhea and failure to gain weight.

Alternate Names:
X-SCID; Common Gamma Chain Deficiency SCID; Bubble Boy Disease

X-Linked Sideroblastic Anemia

An inherited anemia, usually caused by a variant in the *ALAS2* gene. Defective heme production causes iron to build up in developing red blood cells, often producing small, pale red cells.

Alternate Names:
XLSA; ALAS2 Deficiency

X-Linked Spinal and Bulbar Muscular Atrophy

An inherited muscle and nerve disorder that usually begins in adulthood and slowly causes weakness. It may also cause muscle twitching, trouble speak-

ing or swallowing, breast enlargement, and reduced fertility.

Alternate Names:
Kennedy Disease; SBMA; Bulbo-Spinal Muscular Atrophy

XO Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Turner Syndrome*.

XP

Abbreviation for xeroderma pigmentosum, a rare DNA-repair disorder causing extreme sensitivity to ultraviolet light and a markedly increased risk of early skin and eye cancers.

X-Ray

An imaging test that uses a small amount of radiation to create a picture of structures inside the body. It is especially useful for bones, lungs, teeth, and some other tissues.

X-Ray Attenuation

The reduction in intensity of an X-ray beam as it passes through tissue, through absorption and scattering. Different tissues attenuate X-rays by different amounts, creating contrast in an image.

X-Ray Crystallography

A laboratory method that uses X-rays to work out the three-dimensional structure of molecules such as proteins. The molecule is made into a crystal, and the pattern produced by the X-rays is analyzed.

Alternate Names:
X-Ray Crystal Diffraction Analysis

X-Ray Shield

A barrier made of lead or another radiation-absorbing material that reduces exposure to scattered X-rays, especially for staff or the public outside the imaging room. Patient shields can obscure anatomy or interfere with automatic exposure controls, sometimes reducing image quality or increasing radiation dose.

X-Ray Therapy

Treatment that uses carefully aimed X-rays, usually from a machine outside the body, to damage cancer cells or relieve symptoms.

XX Male Syndrome

An older name for 46,XX testicular difference of sex development, in which a person with two X chromosomes develops typically male traits, often because the *SRY* gene has moved onto an X chromosome. Infertility is common.

XXX Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Triple X Syndrome*.

XXXX Syndrome

A rare sex-chromosome variation, also called tetrasomy X, in which a person has four X chromosomes (48,XXXX). Features vary and may include developmental or learning difficulties, differences in physical development, and ovarian dysfunction.

XXY Males

Older name; see *Klinefelter Syndrome*.

XXY Syndrome

Alternate name; see *Klinefelter Syndrome*.

Xylitol

A sugar alcohol used as a sweetener and in some oral-care products. Large amounts can cause abdominal discomfort and diarrhea.

Xylose

A simple sugar found in some plants. A form called D-xylose has been used in tests of how well the small intestine absorbs nutrients and is also used in laboratory studies.

Xylose Absorption Test

A test that measures D-xylose in the blood or urine after it is swallowed to assess absorption by the small intestine. A low result may indicate impaired intestinal absorption, although kidney function and other factors can affect the result.

Alternate Names:
D-Xylose Absorption Test; D-Xylose Tolerance Test

XYY Syndrome

A sex-chromosome variation in which a person has an extra Y chromosome (47,XYY). Many have no obvious physical features; some have tall stature or speech, learning, or developmental difficulties.

Y

YAG Capsulotomy

A laser procedure that makes an opening in the cloudy posterior capsule behind an artificial lens after cataract surgery. It treats posterior capsule opacification, which can blur vision or cause glare.

YAG Laser Capsulotomy

Alternate name; see *YAG Capsulotomy*.

YAG Laser Surgery

An eye procedure using a neodymium-doped yttrium-aluminum-garnet (Nd:YAG) laser to cut or alter tissue. Uses include opening a cloudy lens capsule after cataract surgery and making a peripheral opening in the iris for some forms of angle-closure glaucoma.

Yawn

An involuntary behavior consisting of a deep inhalation followed by a slower exhalation, often with stretching of the jaw and facial muscles. Yawning is common with fatigue but excessive or unusual yawning can occur with some medications or neurologic conditions.

Yawning

See *Yawn*.

Yaws

A chronic skin infection caused by *Treponema pallidum* subspecies *pertenue* and spread by direct contact with an infectious skin lesion. It can cause papillomas and ulcers, followed in some cases by damage to the skin, bone, or cartilage.

Yaws Papilloma

A raised, often painless, raspberry-like skin lesion of early yaws, caused by *Treponema pallidum* subspecies *pertenue*. It may become ulcerated and is also called a mother yaw or frambesioma.

Alternate Names:
Mother Yaw; Frambesioma; Primary Yaws Lesion

Y-Box-Binding Protein 1

A protein that binds DNA and RNA and helps regulate gene activity, RNA processing, and protein production.

Alternate Names:
YB-1; Y-Box Binding Protein; Y-Box Transcription Factor; Nuclease-Sensitive Element-Binding Protein 1

Y Chromosome

One of the two human sex chromosomes. It carries genes involved in testis development and other functions. A biological father passes it to a child who inherits his Y chromosome; sex-chromosome patterns and body development vary.

Y-Chromosome Microdeletion

A small missing section of the Y chromosome, often in an azoospermia-factor (AZF) region. It can impair sperm production, causing a very low sperm count or no sperm in the ejaculate.

Yeast

A type of fungus made of single cells. Some yeasts normally live on or in the body, while others can cause infections of the mouth, skin, vagina, lungs, blood, or other organs.

Yeast Infection

An infection caused by yeast, most often *Candida* species. It may affect the mouth, skin, genital tract, or bloodstream; symptoms depend on the site. Yeast may also be present without causing disease, so detection alone does not establish infection.

Yeast Infection In Women And Men

A lay term for symptomatic Candida infection of genital tissues. Vulvovaginal candidiasis can cause vulvar itching, soreness, and vaginal discharge; candidal balanitis causes redness, itching, or irritation of the glans penis. These conditions are not usually acquired through sexual intercourse and are not generally classified as sexually transmitted infections.

Yeast Infections

See *Yeast Infection*.

Yeast Present

A laboratory report showing yeast in a specimen. This may mean harmless colonization, contamination, or infection; the meaning depends on the symptoms, specimen, and type of yeast.

Yeast Vulvitis

Inflammation of the vulva associated with a Candida yeast infection. It may cause itching, burning, redness, swelling, and soreness; other conditions can cause similar symptoms.

Yellow Cartilage

A flexible type of cartilage containing many elastic fibers. It is found in the outer ear, the epiglottis, parts of the voice box, and the tube connecting the middle ear to the throat.

Alternate Names:
Elastic Cartilage; Cartilago Elastica

Yellow Fever

A serious viral hemorrhagic disease caused by the yellow fever virus, transmitted to humans through the bites of infected mosquitoes in tropical areas of Africa and South America. While many people experience mild illness or recover after initial symptoms of fever, chills, headache, back pain, and nausea, some progress to a severe toxic phase. This phase causes liver damage that produces jaundice (yellowing of the skin and eyes, giving the disease its name), bleeding from the mouth, nose, or stomach, and kidney failure.

Alternate Names:
Flavivirus Hemorrhagic Fever; Yellow Jack

Yellow Fever Vaccine

A live, weakened-virus vaccine that provides long-lasting protection after one dose for most people. Rare serious adverse events include vaccine-associated neurotropic disease (YEL-AND) and viscerotropic disease (YEL-AVD), in which the vaccine virus affects internal organs.

Alternate Names:
17D Vaccine

Yellow Fever Virus

A mosquito-borne flavivirus that causes yellow fever, which ranges from a mild febrile illness to severe disease with jaundice, bleeding, shock, or organ failure.

Yellowish Palms/Soles

Alternate name; see *Carotenemia*.

Yellow Ligament

A series of elastic bands connecting the back parts of neighboring bones in the spine. They help support the spine and surround the spinal canal.

Alternate Names:
Ligamentum Flavum; Flavum Ligament

Yellow Marrow

Bone marrow containing mostly fat instead of blood-forming cells. It is common in the hollow centers of adult long bones and can change back toward blood-forming marrow when the body needs more blood cells.

Alternate Names:
Fatty Bone Marrow; Medulla Ossium Flava

Yellow Nail Syndrome

A rare multisystem disorder classically defined by a triad of symptoms: slow-growing, thickened, yellow-to-green nails that lack cuticles and may separate from the nail bed; chronic respiratory problems, such as persistent cough, chronic bronchitis, or fluid accumulation around the lungs (pleural effusions); and swelling (lymphedema), typically affecting the legs, caused by impaired lymphatic fluid drainage.

Alternate Names:
Primary Lymphedema with Yellow Nails and Pleural Effusion

Yellow-Nail Syndrome

Alternate spelling; see
textitYellow Nail Syndrome.

Yellow Nail Syndrome Triad

The three main features of yellow nail syndrome: slow-growing yellow or thickened nails, swelling from lymph-fluid buildup, and long-term breathing or lung problems.

Alternate Names:
YNS Triad; Lymphedema-Pleural Effusion-Yellow Nails

Yellow Spot

The macula, a small yellowish area near the center of the retina. It contains the fovea, which provides the sharp central vision used for fine detail.

Alternate Names:
Macula Lutea; Anatomical Macula

Yellow Tongue

Yellow discoloration or coating of the tongue that may result from oral hygiene, smoking, dry mouth, diet, medicines, or an underlying illness.

Yergason Test

A shoulder examination performed with the elbow bent and the forearm turned palm-down. The person turns the palm up and rotates the arm outward against resistance; pain over the biceps tendon in the front of the shoulder may suggest biceps tendon disease, but the test alone cannot confirm a diagnosis.

Yersinia

A group of bacteria that can cause intestinal illness, swollen lymph nodes in the abdomen, or plague. Different species spread through contaminated food or water, infected animals, or fleas.

Yersinia Enterocolitica

A bacterium that causes an intestinal infection known as yersiniosis, most commonly contracted by consuming undercooked pork products, unpasteurized milk, or contaminated water. The bacteria infect the lining of the small intestine and surrounding lymph nodes, causing fever, watery or bloody diarrhea, and sharp abdominal pain that often localizes to the lower right side of the belly, frequently mimicking the symptoms of acute appendicitis.

Alternate Names:
Yersinia Enteritis; Yersiniosis Pathogen

Yersinia Enterocolitica Pseudoappendicitis

A Yersinia infection that causes pain in the lower right abdomen and swollen lymph nodes near the intestine, making it resemble appendicitis. It can also cause fever and diarrhea, often after contaminated food such as undercooked pork.

Alternate Names:
Yersinia Mesenteric Adenitis; Pseudoappendiceal Syndrome

Yersinia Infection

An intestinal infection caused mainly by *Yersinia enterocolitica* or *Y. pseudotuberculosis*. It can cause diarrhea, abdominal pain, fever, or vomiting; swollen lymph nodes in the abdomen may cause pain that resembles appendicitis. It is distinct from plague, which is caused by *Y. pestis*.

Yersinia Outer Proteins

Effector proteins made by disease-causing *Yersinia* bacteria and delivered into host cells by a type III secretion system. They disrupt cell signaling and immune defenses, helping the bacteria evade destruction.

Alternate Names:
Yops; Yersinia Effector Proteins; Yop Virulence Factors

Yersinia Pestis

A species of bacterium that causes plague, a severe and historically devastating zoonotic infectious disease. The bacteria naturally circulate among wild rodents and are most commonly transmitted to humans through the bites of infected rodent fleas, though they can also spread through contact with infected animal tissues or via airborne droplets. Depending on how the infection enters the body, it can cause swollen, painful lymph nodes (bubonic plague), spread through the bloodstream (septicemic plague), or infect the lungs (pneumonic plague), causing severe fever and rapid illness.

Alternate Names:
Plague Bacillus; Pasteurella Pestis

Yersinia Pestis Pneumonic Plague

Plague involving the lungs, caused by *Yersinia pestis*. It may follow inhalation of infectious respiratory droplets or spread from plague elsewhere in the body. It can cause fever, cough, chest pain, breathing difficulty, and rapidly worsening lung failure.

Alternate Names:
Pneumonic Plague

Yersinia Pseudotuberculosis

A bacterium usually acquired from contaminated food or water. It can cause fever, diarrhea, and pain from swollen lymph nodes in the abdomen, sometimes resembling appendicitis.

Yersinia Reactive Arthritis

Joint inflammation that develops after a Yersinia intestinal infection, usually one to four weeks later. It often affects a few joints, especially in the legs, without bacteria being present inside the joints.

Yersiniosis

See *Yersinia Infection*.

Yew Poisoning

Poisoning after ingesting yew leaves, seeds, or other toxic parts of the plant. Taxine alkaloids can cause vomiting, dizziness, seizures, dangerous heart rhythms, collapse, and death. The fleshy red covering of the seed is nontoxic, but the seed inside is poisonous, especially if chewed.

Y-Linked Gene

A gene located on the Y chromosome outside its pseudoautosomal regions. Examples include *SRY*, which is involved in testis development, and genes in the AZF regions, which contribute to sperm production. It is passed to children who inherit the Y chromosome from their biological father.

Alternate Names:
Holandric Gene; Y-Chromosomal Gene

Y-Linked Inheritance

Inheritance of a condition caused by a gene on the Y chromosome. A biological father passes the gene to children who inherit his Y chromosome, but not to children who inherit his X chromosome.

Y-Maze Test

A test used mainly in laboratory animals to study movement, exploration, and spatial working memory. The animal moves through three arms of a Y-shaped maze, and the pattern of movement is recorded.

Alternate Names:
Y-Maze Behavioral Paradigm

Yolk Sac

A temporary structure that supports an early embryo before the placenta is fully working. It helps form the first blood cells and part of the early intestine and can be seen on early pregnancy ultrasound.

Yolk Sac Carcinoma

Alternate name; see *Yolk Sac Tumor*.

Yolk Sac Tumor

A rare, fast-growing malignant germ cell tumor that originates from primitive reproductive cells, most

commonly developing in the testes of young boys or the ovaries of young girls, though it can occasionally arise in the tailbone, chest, or brain. The tumor cells resemble the structures of an early embryonic yolk sac and typically produce and secrete elevated amounts of alpha-fetoprotein (AFP) into the bloodstream, which serves as a valuable marker for diagnosis and monitoring.

Alternate Names:
Endodermal Sinus Tumor; Infantile Embryonal Carcinoma; Yolk Sac Germ Cell Tumor

Yolk-Sac Tumor

Alternate name; see *Yolk Sac Tumor*.

Yolk Sac Tumor Pathology

A malignant germ-cell tumor with variable reticular, microcystic, papillary, glandular, or solid patterns. Schiller-Duval bodies, hyaline globules, and alpha-fetoprotein expression may support the diagnosis.

Yolk Sac Tumor Schiller-Duval Bodies

A characteristic microscope finding in yolk sac tumors. It looks somewhat like a tiny kidney filter, with tumor cells arranged around a small blood vessel. The finding helps confirm the diagnosis when considered with other test results.

Alternate Names:
Schiller-Duval Bodies; Glomeruloid Endodermal Bodies

Yolk Stalk

The temporary connection between the yolk sac and the developing midgut. It normally disappears during early development; a persistent remnant can form a Meckel diverticulum, cyst, or fistula.

Young-Burgess Classification

A system that classifies pelvic-ring fractures by injury mechanism and pattern. Main groups are lateral compression, anteroposterior compression, vertical shear, and combined mechanisms.

Alternate Names:
Young-Burgess Pelvic Fracture Classification; Burgess Pelvic Injury Scale

Young-Onset Dementia

Dementia that begins before age 65. It may result from Alzheimer disease, frontotemporal lobar degeneration, vascular disease, or other causes.

Alternate Names:
Presenile Dementia (deprecated historical term)

Young Syndrome

A rare syndrome characterized by chronic sinus inflammation, bronchiectasis (permanent widening and damage of the airways), and obstructive azoospermia (absence of sperm in the ejaculate because sperm transport is blocked despite sperm production).

Alternate Names:
Sinopulmonary-Infertility Syndrome; Barry-Perkins-Young Syndrome

Y-Plate Osteosynthesis

Surgical repair of a complex broken bone using a metal plate shaped like the letter Y. The plate holds the bone pieces in place while they heal.

Alternate Names:
Y-Plate Fixation; Y-Shaped Contoured Bone Plate

Yttrium-90

A radioactive isotope that emits beta particles. It is used in selected treatments to deliver radiation to abnormal tissue, including some liver tumors and inflamed joints.

Yttrium-90 Microspheres

Tiny glass or resin beads containing radioactive yttrium-90. They are delivered through the hepatic artery to selected liver tumors, where they release radiation.

Alternate Names:
Y-90 Radioembolization Microspheres

Yttrium-90 Radioembolization

A treatment in which tiny beads containing radioactive yttrium-90 are delivered through the hepatic artery to release radiation inside liver tumors.

Alternate Names:
SIRT; Y-90 SIRT; Y-90 Transarterial Radioem-

bolization

Neodymium-Doped Yttrium-Aluminum-Garnet Laser

A laser that uses a neodymium-doped yttrium-aluminum-garnet crystal to produce a focused beam of light. In eye care, it is used to open a cloudy membrane after cataract surgery or make a small opening in the iris for some types of glaucoma.

Alternate Names:
Nd:YAG Laser; Neodymium-Doped YAG Laser

Yuzpe Regimen

An emergency-contraception method using combined estrogen and progestin pills. Compared with levonorgestrel or ulipristal pills, it is less effective and more often causes nausea and vomiting.

Y-V Plasty

A surgical technique in which a Y-shaped cut is closed as a V. This lengthens or widens nearby tissue and may help release a tight scar or other narrowing.

Alternate Names:
Y-V Advancement Flap; Y-V Lengthening Procedure

Z

Zafirlukast

A leukotriene-receptor antagonist used for long-term control and prevention of asthma symptoms. It is taken orally and is not a rescue treatment for an acute asthma attack; liver injury and drug interactions are important safety considerations.

Alternate Names:
Accolate

Zahn Lines

Alternating light and dark layers seen in a blood clot that formed while blood was flowing. The light layers contain platelets and fibrin, while the dark layers contain more red blood cells.

Alternate Names:
Lines of Zahn; Striae of Zahn

Zanamivir

An inhaled neuraminidase inhibitor used to treat or prevent influenza A and B. It can cause bronchospasm, including serious episodes, with particular concern in people with asthma or chronic obstructive pulmonary disease.

Alternate Names:
Relenza

ZAP-70 Deficiency

A rare, usually autosomal recessive immune disorder that disrupts T-cell signaling. CD8 T cells are absent or very low, while CD4 T cells are present but do not function normally; serious infections often begin in infancy.

Zavanelli Maneuver

An emergency procedure for severe shoulder dystocia that does not respond to other measures. The clinician gently returns the baby's head to the birth canal, followed by immediate cesarean delivery.

Alternate Names:
Cephalic Replacement Maneuver

Z-Disc

A dense protein structure at each end of a sarcomere, the repeating contractile unit of a muscle fiber. It anchors actin and titin filaments and forms the boundary between neighboring sarcomeres.

Alternate Names:
Z-Line; Z-Band; Zwischenscheibe

Zellweger Syndrome

A rare, severe inherited metabolic disorder caused by genetic mutations that prevent the normal formation and function of peroxisomes, tiny cellular structures necessary for breaking down specific fatty acids and producing essential brain lipids. Without functional peroxisomes, toxic very long-chain fatty acids accumulate in cells throughout the body. Present from birth, it causes profound muscle weakness (hypotonia), distinctive facial features, feeding difficulties, severe vision and hearing impairment, liver disease, and progressive neurological impairment.

Alternate Names:
Cerebrohepatorenal Syndrome; Generalized Peroxisomal Biogenesis Disorder

Zenker Degeneration

Severe damage and death of skeletal muscle fibers, formerly described in serious infections such as typhoid fever or widespread blood infection.

Alternate Names:
Zenker's Hyaline Necrosis; Waxy Muscle Degeneration

Zenker Diverticulum

An abnormal pouch or sac that forms in the back of the throat, just above the esophagus, where the muscular wall of the pharynx is naturally thinner. It develops when the muscle at the top of the esophagus fails to relax properly during swallowing, creating increased pressure that forces the inner throat lining to bulge outward. As food particles and liquids become trapped in the pouch, it causes difficulty swallowing (dysphagia), regurgitation of undigested food hours after eating, persistent bad breath, coughing, and a sensation of a lump in the throat.

Alternate Names:
Zenker's Diverticulum; Pharyngoesophageal Diverticulum; Hypopharyngeal Pulsion Diverticulum

Zenker Peroral Endoscopic Myotomy

An endoscopic procedure for Zenker diverticulum in which the cricopharyngeal muscle between the pouch and swallowing tube is divided through the mouth. This can improve passage of food; symptoms can return, and complications can include bleeding or perforation.

Alternate Names:
Z-POEM; Endoscopic Zenker Myotomy

Ziconotide

A non-opioid pain medicine that blocks N-type calcium channels in nerves. It is given by continuous infusion into the fluid around the spinal cord for selected cases of severe chronic pain and can cause serious neurologic or psychiatric effects.

Alternate Names:
Prialt

Zidovudine

A nucleoside reverse-transcriptase inhibitor used with other antiretroviral medicines to treat HIV infection. In selected settings, it is also given during labor and to exposed newborns to reduce perinatal transmission; adverse effects include anemia and low white-cell counts.

Alternate Names:
Azidothymidine; AZT; Retrovir

Ziehl-Neelsen Stain

A specialized laboratory staining technique used in microbiology to identify acid-fast bacteria, most notably *Mycobacterium tuberculosis*, the cause of tuberculosis. Because mycobacteria have a thick, waxy lipid layer in their cell walls that resists conventional Gram staining, this method uses a bright red dye (carbolfuchsin) heated to penetrate the waxy wall, followed by an acid-alcohol rinse. The bacteria retain the bright red color while the background tissue turns blue, making them visible under a microscope.

Alternate Names:
ZN Stain; Acid-Fast Bacilli Stain; AFB Stain

Zieve Syndrome

A short-lived complication of heavy alcohol use, characterized by hemolytic anemia, jaundice, and increased blood fats, often during acute alcohol-related liver injury.

Alternate Names:
Hemolytic Anemia with Hyperlipidemia and Jaundice

Zika

See *Zika Virus Infection*.

Alternate Names:
Zika Virus Disease; ZVD

Zika Fever

The usually mild febrile illness caused by Zika virus. It may include rash, red eyes, joint pain, muscle pain, headache, and fever; infection during pregnancy can harm the developing fetus.

Zika Virus

A virus spread mainly by infected *Aedes* mosquitoes and also through sexual contact and, less commonly, blood or pregnancy-related transmission. Infection is often mild or symptom-free but can injure a developing fetus.

Alternate Names:

ZIKV

Zika Virus Infection

A viral infection caused by the Zika virus, transmitted to humans primarily through the bites of infected *Aedes* mosquitoes, as well as through sexual contact or from a pregnant woman to her fetus. Most adults infected with the virus experience either no symptoms or a mild, temporary illness with fever, rash, joint pain, and red eyes (conjunctivitis). However, infection during pregnancy carries a serious risk of causing severe fetal brain abnormalities, particularly microcephaly (an abnormally small head and underdeveloped brain).

Alternate Names:
Zika Fever; Congenital Zika Syndrome Pathogen

Zileuton

A 5-lipoxygenase inhibitor used for long-term control of asthma by reducing leukotriene production. It does not relieve a sudden asthma attack and can cause liver injury or interact with other medicines.

Alternate Names:
Zyflo

Zinc

An essential mineral needed for many body reactions, normal growth, immunity, reproduction, and wound healing. Too little can cause deficiency; excessive supplements can cause stomach symptoms and copper deficiency.

Alternate Names:
Zn

Zinc Acetate

An oral zinc salt used to treat zinc deficiency and to reduce copper absorption in Wilson disease. In the intestine, it increases metallothionein, a protein that binds copper and limits its entry into the blood; it may cause stomach irritation.

Zinc Deficiency

Inadequate zinc status caused by low intake, impaired absorption, excessive losses, or increased requirements. Features vary with age and severity and may include impaired growth, dermatitis, alopecia, diarrhea, altered taste, delayed wound healing, and increased susceptibility to infection.

Alternate Names:
Zinc Depletion

Zinc Finger Motif

A small part of a protein held in shape by a zinc atom. It often helps the protein attach to DNA and control gene activity.

Zinc Oxide

An insoluble zinc compound used topically as a skin protectant and barrier, including in preparations for diaper dermatitis and minor irritation.

Alternate Names:
ZnO

Zinc Oxide Ointment

A topical preparation containing zinc oxide that forms a protective barrier over irritated or moist skin. It is commonly used for diaper dermatitis and minor skin irritation.

Zinc Poisoning

Illness caused by excessive zinc intake or exposure. Swallowing too much can cause nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea; inhaling zinc-oxide fumes can cause metal-fume fever. Prolonged excess can interfere with copper absorption and cause anemia or neurologic problems.

Zinc Protoporphyrin

A form of protoporphyrin containing zinc, produced in developing red blood cells when iron is unavailable or lead interferes with heme production. Levels can rise in iron deficiency and lead exposure, but the test is not specific to either condition.

Alternate Names:
ZPP; Erythrocyte Zinc Protoporphyrin

Zinc Sulfate

An oral or parenteral zinc salt used to prevent or treat zinc deficiency when clinically indicated. Gastrointestinal upset is common with oral therapy, and prolonged excessive use can cause copper deficiency.

Zinc Toxicity

Alternate name; see *Zinc Poisoning*.

Zinner Syndrome

A rare congenital condition combining absence of one kidney, a cyst of the seminal vesicle on the same side, and blockage of the ejaculatory duct. It may cause pelvic pain, painful urination, or infertility after puberty.

Alternate Names:
Mesonephric Duct Malformation Syndrome; Seminal Vesicle Cyst with Renal Agenesis

Zirconia

A zirconium-oxide ceramic used in dentistry for crowns, bridges, implants, and other restorations. Its strength and tissue compatibility make it useful, although restoration design, surface treatment, and clinical indication affect performance.

Alternate Names:
Zirconium Dioxide

Zoledronic Acid

A potent intravenous bisphosphonate used for osteoporosis and certain cancer-related conditions, including hypercalcemia of malignancy and skeletal complications of bone metastases. Renal injury, hypocalcemia, acute-phase reactions, and rare osteonecrosis of the jaw are important risks.

Alternate Names:
Zoledronate; Zometa; Reclast

Zollinger-Ellison Secretin Stimulation Test

A blood test used when Zollinger–Ellison syndrome is suspected but fasting gastrin results are unclear. Secretin is given into a vein, and blood gastrin is measured before and after the injection; an abnormal rise supports the diagnosis.

Alternate Names:
Secretin Provocation Test; Secretin Gastrinoma Test

Zollinger-Ellison Syndrome

A rare digestive disorder caused by one or more tumors, called gastrinomas, that usually form in the pancreas or the upper small intestine (duodenum). These tumors produce abnormally large amounts of gastrin, a hormone that stimulates the stomach to secrete excessive gastric acid. The constant acid flood causes severe, recurrent peptic ulcers in the stomach and intestine, abdominal pain, chronic diarrhea, and heartburn that often resist standard acid-reducing treatments.

Alternate Names:
ZES; Gastrinoma Syndrome

Zolpidem

A sedative-hypnotic medicine used to treat insomnia. It can cause next-day impairment, complex sleep behaviors, dependence, and central-nervous-system depression, especially with other sedatives.

Alternate Names:
Ambien

Zona Fasciculata

The middle and largest layer of the adrenal cortex. It produces glucocorticoids, including cortisol.

Alternate Names:
Adrenal Zona Fasciculata; Fascicular Zone

Zona Glomerulosa

The outer layer of the adrenal cortex. It produces mineralocorticoids, mainly aldosterone, which helps regulate salt and water balance and blood pressure.

Alternate Names:
Adrenal Zona Glomerulosa; Glomerular Zone

Zona Pellucida

A protective layer of proteins surrounding an egg cell. It helps sperm attach to the egg and changes after fertilization to prevent more than one sperm from entering.

Alternate Names:
Oocyte Glycoprotein Coat; Pellucid Zone

Zona Reticularis

The inner layer of the adrenal cortex. It produces adrenal androgens, including dehydroepiandrosterone (DHEA).

Alternate Names:

Adrenal Zona Reticularis; Reticular Zone

Zonisamide

An antiseizure medicine used mainly for focal-onset seizures. It can cause sleepiness, thinking problems, kidney stones, reduced sweating with overheating, acid imbalance, severe rash, or other serious reactions.

Alternate Names:
Zonegran

Zonula Adherens

A belt-like connection between neighboring cells that helps hold them together by linking their actin networks. It is especially important in sheets of lining cells.

Alternate Names:
Intermediate Junction; Adherens Junction

Zonula Occludens

A tight connection between neighboring lining cells that helps prevent substances from passing freely between them.

Alternate Names:
Tight Junction

Zonule

Fine fibers that connect the ciliary body to the lens capsule and hold the lens in place. Changes in their tension help the lens adjust focus for near or distant vision.

Alternate Names:
Zonule of Zinn; Ciliary Zonule; Suspensory Ligament of Lens

Zoon Balanitis

A chronic benign inflammation of the glans penis, usually seen in uncircumcised men. It commonly appears as a sharply demarcated shiny orange-red or rust-colored patch; diagnosis is clinical, with biopsy used when the diagnosis is uncertain.

Alternate Names:
Plasma Cell Balanitis; Balanitis Circumscripta Plasmacellularis; Zoon's Balanitis; Zoon's Balanitis

Zoonosis

An infection that naturally spreads between animals with backbones and people. Examples include rabies, brucellosis, leptospirosis, toxoplasmosis, and some influenza infections; spread may involve bites, food, water, droplets, or direct contact.

Alternate Names:
Zoonotic Infection; Zoonotic Disease

Zoonotic Spillover

Transmission of an infectious agent from an animal host to a person, sometimes through an insect or other arthropod vector. Further spread between people may or may not follow.

Alternate Names:
Zoonotic Transmission Event; Cross-Species Spillover

Zoster

A painful, usually unilateral vesicular eruption caused by reactivation of latent varicella-zoster virus in a sensory nerve ganglion. It may be complicated by postherpetic neuralgia, ocular disease, or neurologic involvement.

Alternate Names:
Herpes Zoster; Shingles; Zona

Zoster Ophthalmicus

Shingles affecting the ophthalmic branch of the trigeminal nerve, which supplies the forehead, upper eyelid, and parts of the eye. It can cause a one-sided rash and inflammation that threatens vision.

Alternate Names:
Herpes Zoster Ophthalmicus; HZO

Zoster (Shingles)

Alternate name; see *Zoster*.

Z-Plasty

A reconstructive operation that rearranges nearby skin in a Z-shaped pattern. It can lengthen a tight scar, change the direction of a scar, and improve movement or appearance.

Z-Score (DXA)

A measure from dual-energy X-ray absorptiometry (DXA) showing how many standard deviations bone mineral density is above or below an age-, sex-, and ethnicity-matched reference mean. In children with short stature or growth delay, results may be adjusted for height. A score of −2.0 or lower is "below the expected range for age." In children, osteoporosis is indicated by a qualifying vertebral compression fracture without high-energy trauma or local disease, or by both a clinically significant fracture history and a BMD Z-score of −2.0 or lower. The score alone does not diagnose osteoporosis in premenopausal women or men younger than 50.

Alternate Names:
Age-Matched Bone Density Z-Score; DEXA Z-Score; Z-Score (DEXA)

Z-Score (Echocardiography)

The number of standard deviations a child's heart or blood-vessel measurement is above or below the expected value for body size, usually body surface area. It helps describe whether a structure is smaller or larger than expected.

Alternate Names:
Pediatric Echo Z-Score; Cardiovascular Z-Score

Z-Thumb Deformity

A thumb deformity in which the metacarpophalangeal joint is flexed and the interphalangeal joint is extended, creating a Z shape. It can occur in rheumatoid arthritis.

Alternate Names:
Boutonniere-Type Thumb Deformity

Z-Tracking Technique

An intramuscular injection method in which the skin is moved to one side before the injection and released afterward. The resulting angled path helps keep medicine in the muscle and limits leakage into tissue beneath the skin.

Alternate Names:
Z-Track Injection Method; Z-Track Technique

Zygapophyseal Joint

One of the small joints at the back of the spine that connects neighboring vertebrae. These facet joints guide spinal movement and can become painful with arthritis.

Alternate Names:
Facet Joint; Z-Joint; Spinal Articular Facet

Zygapophyseal Joint Arthropathy

Arthritis of the small facet joints at the back of the spine. It can cause local or nearby neck or back pain and stiffness.

Alternate Names:
Facet Joint Arthropathy; Spinal Facet Osteoarthritis

Zygomatic Arch

The bony arch at the side of the face, formed by the cheekbone and temporal bone. It provides attachment for the masseter muscle, and the temporalis tendon passes beneath it.

Alternate Names:
Cheekbone Arch

Zygomatic Bone

A paired facial bone that forms the prominence of the cheek and part of the lateral orbital wall and floor. It articulates with the frontal, sphenoid, temporal, and maxillary bones.

Alternate Names:
Cheekbone; Malar Bone

Zygomatic Fracture

A break in the cheekbone, usually caused by facial trauma. It may flatten the cheek, numb the skin below the eye, cause double vision, limit mouth opening, or extend into the eye socket.

Alternate Names:
Malar Fracture

Zygomaticomaxillary Complex Fracture

A break involving the cheekbone and its connections to the eye socket, upper jaw, and skull. It may flatten the cheek and cause double vision, numbness below the eye, or difficulty opening the mouth.

Alternate Names:
ZMC Fracture; Tetrapod Fracture; Tripod Fracture

of the Face

Zygomycosis

An outdated, broad term for fungal infections caused by fungi once grouped as zygomycetes. It has often been used imprecisely for mucormycosis, which is caused by fungi in the order Mucorales.

Zygote

The first cell formed when a sperm joins an egg. It contains genetic material from both parents, divides repeatedly, and develops into an embryo.

Alternate Names:
Fertilized Oocyte

Zymogen

An inactive form of an enzyme that becomes active, usually after a protein segment is removed. Examples include pepsinogen, trypsinogen, and some blood-clotting proteins.

Alternate Names:
Proenzyme; Inactive Enzyme Precursor

Zymogen Granule

A small storage sac inside certain gland cells, such as cells in the pancreas. It stores inactive digestive enzymes until the cell releases them.

Alternate Names:
Zymogenic Secretory Vesicle; Proenzyme Granule

Drugs and Related Medical Terms

Medicines and Related Clinical Terms

5-Alpha Reductase Inhibitor

A medicine that lowers production of dihydrotestosterone, a hormone that affects the prostate and hair follicles. It is used mainly for an enlarged prostate and selected types of hair loss.

Abortifacient

A medicine or substance used to end a pregnancy. Some block progesterone, others cause uterine contractions and cervical opening, and certain medicines stop rapidly dividing pregnancy tissue in selected ectopic pregnancies.

Abortion - Medication

Medication abortion uses prescribed medicines, commonly mifepristone followed by misoprostol or misoprostol alone, to end an early intrauterine pregnancy; confirmation of completion and assessment for ectopic pregnancy are important.

Abuse Steroid (Anabolic Steroid Abuse)

Alternate index label for Anabolic Steroid Abuse.

ACE Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks angiotensin-converting enzyme, reducing production of angiotensin II and breakdown of bradykinin. It is used for high blood pressure, heart failure, and selected kidney and cardiovascular conditions; possible effects include cough, high potassium, reduced kidney function, and angioedema.

Alternate Names:
Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme Inhibitor

Acitretin

An oral retinoid medicine used mainly for severe psoriasis and keratinization disorders. It helps normalize skin cell growth and shedding, but because it causes severe birth defects, it cannot be used during or near pregnancy.

Adenovirus Vaccine

A vaccine used primarily to prevent adenovirus types 4 and 7 among selected military personnel. It is an oral, live vaccine and is not part of routine vaccination for the general public. Vaccine use and eligibility depend on current public-health recommendations.

Adverse Drug Event

Harm related to the use of a medication, including harm caused by an adverse drug reaction, medication error, overdose, or inappropriate use.

Adverse Drug Reaction

An unwanted and harmful response to a medicine taken at a usual dose for prevention, testing, or treatment. It may result from the medicine's expected effects, an allergy, an interaction, or an unusual individual response.

Agent, Tocolytic

A medicine that reduces uterine contractions, used selectively to delay preterm birth long enough for corticosteroids, transfer, or other preparations to take effect.

Agonist-Antagonist

A medicine that activates some receptors while blocking others, or activates a receptor only partly. Its mixed action can produce a desired effect while limiting another effect; examples include some opioid medicines.

AIDS Vaccine

A vaccine designed to prevent HIV infection or reduce its effects; no generally effective licensed vaccine currently exists.

Alendronate

A bisphosphonate that reduces bone resorption and is used to treat or prevent osteoporosis and selected other disorders of excessive bone turnover.

Alternate Names:
Alendronic acid; oral bisphosphonate therapy.

Anabolic Steroid Abuse

Non-medical use of synthetic testosterone derivatives to increase muscle mass and athletic performance, which can cause hormonal imbalances, liver injury, elevated cardiovascular risk, mood disturbances, and physical dependence.

Alternate Names:
Abuse Steroid (Anabolic Steroid Abuse)

Analgesic

A medicine that relieves pain without necessarily causing loss of consciousness. Analgesics include nonopioid medicines, opioids, and other medicines chosen according to the type and severity of pain.

Analgesic Nephropathy

Chronic tubulointerstitial renal injury associated with prolonged or excessive use of analgesic medicines. It may cause impaired urinary concentration, sterile pyuria, haematuria, papillary necrosis, hypertension, and progressive chronic kidney disease.

Anesthetic

A medicine that causes loss of sensation, with or without loss of consciousness. Local and regional anesthetics block sensation in part of the body; general anesthetics produce unconsciousness.

Angiotensin Converting-Enzyme Inhibitor

See *ACE Inhibitor*.

Angiotensin Receptor Blocker

A medicine that blocks angiotensin II at the AT1 receptor, reducing vasoconstriction and aldosterone effects; it is used for hypertension, heart failure, and selected kidney disease.

Antibiotic

A medication that inhibits the growth of or destroys bacteria. Antibiotics target bacterial structures such as cell walls and bacterial ribosomes, and they are ineffective against viral infections such as the common cold or influenza.

Antibiotic-Associated Colitis

Inflammation of the colon associated with antibiotic use. *Clostridioides difficile* infection is an important cause, but antibiotic-associated colitis is not limited to pseudomembranous colitis.

Antibiotic-Associated Diarrhea

Loose or frequent stools that occur during or soon after antibiotic treatment.

Alternate Names:
Diarrhea, Antibiotic-Associated

Antibiotic Cycling

A strategy in which the preferred antibiotic for a particular clinical use is changed at planned intervals. It is intended to limit selection of resistant organisms, although its benefit depends on local conditions and implementation.

Antibiotic De-Escalation

The process of narrowing antimicrobial spectrum based on microbiological results and clinical response. De-escalation aims to reduce selective pressure for resistance while maintaining therapeutic efficacy.

Antibiotic Mixing

A strategy in which different antibiotics are assigned concurrently to different patients with the same indication. It is intended to reduce uniform selection pressure for resistance in a patient population.

Antibiotic Resistance

The ability of bacteria to survive or grow despite an antibiotic that would normally kill them or stop their growth. It can result from genetic changes and the spread of resistance genes; unnecessary or incorrect antibiotic use can accelerate it.

Alternate Names:
Resistance Antibiotic (Antibiotic Resistance)

Antibiotic Resistance Genes

Genes that help bacteria survive antibiotics. They may change the antibiotic's target, destroy or modify the medicine, or remove it from the cell. Bacteria can inherit these genes or acquire them from other bacteria.

Antibiotic Stewardship

Coordinated efforts to use antibiotics appropriately by selecting the right medicine, dose, route, and duration while reducing unnecessary treatment and resistance.

Anticholinergic Cognitive Burden Scale

A medication-review tool that estimates the total anticholinergic load of a patient's medicines. It supports risk assessment and deprescribing but does not replace individualized clinical judgment.

Anticoagulant

A medicine that slows the body's blood-clotting process. It helps prevent or treat clots in veins, lungs, heart, or arteries but can cause bruising or serious bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Anticoagulants; Blood Thinners

Anticoagulant Agent

See *Anticoagulant*.

Anticoagulant Monitoring

Laboratory assessment used to measure the effect or safety of an anticoagulant. The appropriate test depends on the drug and may include aPTT, anti-Xa activity, INR, or measurements of kidney function and blood counts.

Anticoagulant Rodenticides Poisoning

Toxic exposure to rodent poisons that inhibit vitamin K recycling in the body. This prevents the liver from synthesizing essential blood-clotting factors, leading to internal hemorrhage, bruising, and hematuria.

Anticonvulsant

A medicine used to prevent or control seizures. Some are also used for nerve pain, migraine prevention, or mood disorders; choice depends on the condition, other medicines, pregnancy, and side effects.

Alternate Names:
Antiseizure medicine

Anticonvulsant Mood Stabilizers

Antiepileptic drugs used as mood stabilizers in bipolar disorder. Valproate (divalproex) is effective for acute mania and rapid cycling. Carbamazepine is effective for acute mania but has numerous drug interactions via CYP3A4 induction. Lamotrigine is effective for bipolar depression prevention but not acute mania.

Antidepressant

A medicine used to treat depressive disorders and some other conditions involving mood, anxiety, pain, or sleep.

Antidiabetic Agent

See *Antidiabetic Drugs*.

Antidiarrheal

A medication that reduces the frequency, volume, or liquidity of bowel movements, typically by slowing intestinal muscle contractions or decreasing fluid secretion into the bowel.

Alternate Names:

Antidiarrheals; Antidiarrheal Medicines

Antidiarrheal Medicine Overdose

Poisoning caused by excessive intake of antidiarrheal medications, which can lead to severe constipation, paralytic ileus, central nervous system depression, and dangerous cardiac conduction disturbances.

Antiemetic

A medicine that prevents or reduces nausea and vomiting. The choice depends on the cause, such as infection, migraine, pregnancy, surgery, or cancer treatment, and some medicines can cause sleepiness or movement problems.

Alternate Names:
Antiemetics; Antiemetic Medicines

Antiestrogen

A drug that blocks estrogen effects or reduces estrogen production; it may be used in hormone-sensitive breast cancer or to alter reproductive hormone signaling.

Antifungal

A medicine that kills fungi or inhibits their growth. Antifungals include azoles, polyenes, echinocandins, and allylamines; the drug and route depend on the fungus and site of infection.

Alternate Names:
Antifungals; Antifungal Drugs

Antifungal Agent

See *Antifungal*.

Antifungal Drug Classes

Major classes of antifungal agents include polyenes (amphotericin B), azoles (fluconazole, voriconazole), echinocandins (caspofungin, micafungin), and allylamines (terbinafine). Polyenes bind to ergosterol in fungal cell membranes. Azoles inhibit ergosterol synthesis. Echinocandins inhibit cell wall synthesis.

Antifungal Medication

See *Antifungal*.

Antihistamine

A medicine that blocks histamine receptors. H1 antihistamines relieve symptoms such as sneezing, itching, and hives; older H1 antihistamines can also cause sleepiness, dry mouth, blurred vision, urinary retention, or confusion. H2 antihistamines reduce stomach acid.

Antihypertensive

A medicine used to lower blood pressure. Classes include ACE inhibitors, angiotensin-receptor blockers, calcium-channel blockers, thiazide-type diuretics, beta-blockers, and other agents. Selection depends on blood pressure, kidney function, cardiovascular disease, pregnancy, and other clinical factors.

Alternate Names:
Antihypertensives; Blood Pressure-Lowering Medicines

Antihypertensive Agent

See *Antihypertensive*.

Anti-Infective

A medicine or other agent used to prevent or treat an infection. The choice depends on whether the cause is a bacterium, virus, fungus, or parasite, as well as the infection site and the person's health.

Antimalarial

A drug used to prevent or treat malaria caused by Plasmodium parasites; selection depends on species, disease severity, resistance, and geographic exposure.

Antimicrobial Drug

A medicine used to treat infection by bacteria, viruses, fungi, or parasites; the drug is selected according to the organism, infection site, and patient factors.

Antimicrobial Drug Interactions

Alterations in the absorption, metabolism, or blood levels of an antimicrobial drug caused by concurrent exposure to other medications, food, or supplements, which can reduce therapeutic efficacy or increase

toxicity.

Antiparasitic

A medicine used to prevent or treat infection caused by parasites. The choice depends on the parasite, body site, disease severity, resistance patterns, pregnancy status, and other patient factors.

Alternate Names:
Antiparasitics; Antiparasitic Medicines; Antiparasitic Drugs

Antiparkinsonian

A medicine used to improve movement or other symptoms of Parkinson disease. Medicines may replace dopamine, imitate its effects, or alter other brain signals; benefits and adverse effects vary with the drug and the person.

Antiplatelet Agent

A medicine that makes blood platelets less likely to clump together. It lowers the risk of clots in arteries but can increase bruising and serious bleeding.

Alternate Names:
Antiplatelet medicine

Antiprotozoal Drug

A medicine used to prevent or treat disease caused by protozoa, including drugs directed against malaria, intestinal protozoa, or tissue parasites.

Antipruritic

A medicine or skin treatment that relieves itching. It may work by reducing inflammation, blocking allergy signals, numbing the skin, or changing nerve signals; treatment should also address the cause of the itching.

Antipsychotic

A medicine used to reduce hallucinations, delusions, severe agitation, or mania and to treat some mood disorders. Possible effects include sleepiness, movement problems, weight or blood-sugar changes, and rarely a dangerous fever-and-stiffness reaction.

Alternate Names:
Antipsychotics; Antipsychotic Medicines

Antipsychotic Agent

See *Antipsychotic*.

Antipsychotic-Induced Parkinsonism

A drug-induced movement disorder caused by dopamine receptor blockade in the basal ganglia, characterized by resting tremor, muscle rigidity, slowed voluntary movement, and postural instability.

Antispasmodic

A medicine that relaxes involuntary muscle and may reduce cramping in the intestine, bladder, or other organs. Some types can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, or confusion.

Alternate Names:
Antispasmodics

Antithyroid

See *Antithyroid Drug*.

Antithyroid Drug

A medicine that reduces thyroid hormone production, used to treat some forms of hyperthyroidism. Examples include methimazole and propylthiouracil. Radioactive iodine is a separate treatment, not an antithyroid drug.

Alternate Names:
Antithyroid Medicines; Antithyroid Drugs

Antiviral

A medicine that slows or stops viruses from multiplying. It works only against certain viruses and is chosen according to the infection, timing, resistance, and the patient's health.

Alternate Names:
Antivirals; Antiviral Medicines; Antiviral Drugs

Antiviral Drug Classes

Groups of antiviral medicines classified by the step of viral growth they block. Some stop copying of viral genetic material, some block viral proteins or entry into cells, and others prevent newly formed viruses from being released.

Anxiolytic

A medicine used to reduce anxiety. Different medicines work in different ways and have different risks; choice depends on the condition, urgency, other health problems, and patient factors. Psychotherapy is a separate, non-medicine treatment for anxiety.

Alternate Names:
Anxiolytics; Anti-Anxiety Medicines

ARB-Neprilysin Inhibitor

Sacubitril/valsartan combines an ARB with a neprilysin inhibitor, increasing natriuretic peptide levels while blocking the renin-angiotensin system. The PARADIGM-HF trial demonstrated superior reduction in cardiovascular death and heart failure hospitalization compared to enalapril.

Aromatase Inhibitor

A class of medications that inhibit aromatase, the enzyme that converts androgens (androstenedione, testosterone) to estrogens (estrone, estradiol) in peripheral tissues (adipose, breast, muscle, bone). Used primarily in hormone receptor-positive breast cancer in postmenopausal women.

Attenuated Vaccine

A vaccine made with a weakened microorganism that retains the ability to stimulate immunity.

Alternate Names:
Live attenuated vaccine

Bacterial Vaccine

A vaccine made from killed bacteria, weakened bacteria, purified bacterial parts, or bacterial toxins. It trains the immune system to prevent specific infections; protection and dosing depend on the vaccine and age group.

BCG Vaccine

A vaccine made from a weakened relative of the tuberculosis bacterium. It helps protect children from severe tuberculosis, especially meningitis, but protection against lung tuberculosis varies; use depends on local risk and policy.

Behavioral Medicine

An interdisciplinary field integrating behavioral science with medical practice to prevent, diagnose, and treat illness. It addresses psychological factors such as stress, coping, adherence, and health behaviors that influence disease outcomes.

Benzodiazepines

Medicines that strengthen the brain's main calming signal. They can reduce anxiety, stop some seizures, relax muscles, or cause sleepiness, but can also cause dependence, falls, confusion, and dangerously slow breathing, especially with opioids or alcohol.

Beta-Adrenergic Blocker

A drug that antagonizes beta-adrenergic receptors, reducing heart rate, myocardial contractility, and renin release. It is used in selected patients with hypertension, angina, arrhythmias, post-myocardial infarction disease, and heart failure; abrupt withdrawal may worsen ischemia.

Alternate Names:
Beta-Adrenergic Antagonist

Beta Agonists

Drugs that activate beta-adrenergic receptors, producing effects such as relaxation of airway smooth muscle or increased cardiac stimulation depending on receptor selectivity.

Alternate Names:
Beta-adrenergic agonists; beta-agonist drugs.

Beta Blocker

See *Beta Blockers*.

Beta-Blocker Overdose

Toxic exposure to excessive beta-adrenergic antagonist medication, resulting in profound suppression of heart rate, low blood pressure, cardiac conduction blocks, hypoglycemia, and potential cardiogenic shock.

Beta Blockers

Medicines that block some effects of adrenaline at beta receptors. They commonly slow the heart rate

and lower blood pressure and are used for several heart conditions and other problems. Some types can worsen asthma or mask warning signs of low blood sugar.

Beta-Lactamase Inhibitor Combinations

Combinations of beta-lactam antibiotics with beta-lactamase inhibitors that extend activity against beta-lactamase producing organisms. The major combinations include amoxicillin-clavulanate, ampicillin-sulbactam, piperacillin-tazobactam, cefoperazone-sulbactam, and ceftolozane-tazobactam.

C1 Esterase Inhibitor

A blood protein that regulates complement and contact-system activity. C1-inhibitor medicines replace or supplement this protein to prevent or treat attacks of hereditary angioedema.

Calcium Channel Blocker

A medicine that reduces calcium movement into heart and blood-vessel muscle cells. It may relax arteries, lower blood pressure, reduce chest pain, or slow some abnormal heart rhythms; ankle swelling, constipation, dizziness, or a slow heartbeat may occur.

Calcium Channel Blocker Overdose

Toxic exposure to excessive calcium channel blocking drugs, resulting in impaired cardiac pacemaker activity, profound arterial vasodilation, severe hypotension, bradycardia, and hyperglycemia.

Calcium Channel Blockers

Medicines that reduce the movement of calcium into heart and blood-vessel muscle cells. Dihydropyridines, such as amlodipine and nifedipine, mainly relax arteries and are used for high blood pressure and angina. Other calcium channel blockers, such as diltiazem and verapamil, also slow the heart rate and electrical conduction and may be used for certain abnormal heart rhythms.

Camptothecin Analogue

A cancer medicine related to camptothecin that blocks an enzyme cancer cells need to copy DNA. It can damage rapidly dividing cells and commonly causes low blood counts, diarrhea, nausea, or other gastrointestinal effects.

Cancer Vaccine

A vaccine designed either to prevent infections that can cause cancer or to help the immune system attack an existing cancer. Its use depends on the specific vaccine and cancer; it does not replace other cancer treatment when needed.

Cardiotonic Agent

A medication or chemical substance that strengthens the contraction of the heart muscle and improves cardiac output in conditions such as congestive heart failure and cardiogenic shock.

Carvedilol Phosphate

The phosphate formulation of carvedilol, a medicine that blocks beta and alpha-1 receptors. It lowers heart rate and blood pressure and is used for heart failure and hypertension; dizziness, slow heartbeat, and worsening fluid retention can occur.

Celecoxib

A selective COX-2 anti-inflammatory medicine used for pain and arthritis. It can cause stomach, kidney, blood-pressure, and heart problems and may increase cardiovascular risk, especially with long-term use or in people with existing risk factors.

Alternate Names:
Celebrex

Cholesterol - Drug Treatment

Medicines used to lower harmful blood cholesterol or triglycerides and reduce cardiovascular risk. Statins are used most often; other options may be added when needed, according to cholesterol levels, overall risk, other illnesses, and treatment tolerance.

Cholinesterase Inhibitor

A medicine that slows the breakdown of acetylcholine, a chemical used for nerve signalling. It can improve nerve communication in selected conditions but may cause nausea, diarrhoea, slow heartbeat,

sweating, or muscle cramps.

Cold/Cough Medicines in Children

Medicines marketed to relieve cold or cough symptoms in children, including antihistamines, decongestants, antitussives, and expectorants. Their safety and effectiveness vary by ingredient and age; some can cause serious adverse effects or accidental overdose in young children.

Conjugate Vaccine

A vaccine that joins a bacterial sugar to a carrier protein so the immune system makes a stronger, longer-lasting response. This design is especially useful in infants and young children.

Alternate Names:
Protein-conjugate vaccine; conjugated polysaccharide vaccine.

Conscious Sedation

A drug-induced depression of consciousness during which a patient remains able to respond purposefully to verbal commands and light tactile stimulation while maintaining spontaneous breathing and protective airway reflexes.

Alternate Names:
Moderate Sedation; Moderate Procedural Sedation

Controlled Substance

A medicine or chemical whose production, supply, possession, or use is restricted by law because it may cause dependence, misuse, overdose, or other serious harm. Rules differ between countries and substances.

Cox-1 Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks cyclooxygenase-1, an enzyme involved in protecting the stomach lining, maintaining kidney blood flow, and producing platelet thromboxane. Inhibition can increase the risk of gastrointestinal bleeding and kidney effects.

COX Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks cyclooxygenase-1, cyclooxygenase-2, or both, reducing production of prostaglandins involved in pain, fever, and inflammation. Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drugs are COX inhibitors; adverse effects can include gastrointestinal bleeding, kidney problems, and cardiovascular events.

Crack (Drug)

A smokable, rapidly acting form of cocaine; it can cause dependence, severe cardiovascular effects, seizures, stroke, psychiatric symptoms, and overdose.

Cutaneous Drug Eruptions

Adverse skin reactions triggered by systemic medications, ranging from mild widespread red rashes and hives to severe blistering reactions with epidermal detachment and mucous membrane involvement.

Cyclooxygenase Inhibitor

See *COX Inhibitor*.

Designer Steroid

A chemically modified anabolic-androgenic steroid created to produce performance-enhancing effects or evade detection; products may be unapproved, contaminated, and medically dangerous.

Diarrhea, Antibiotic-Associated

Alternate index label; see *Antibiotic-Associated Diarrhea*.

Digitalis

A group of heart medicines from foxglove plants, including digoxin. They can strengthen heart contraction and slow some heart rhythms but have a narrow safety range and may cause dangerous toxicity.

Diphtheria Vaccine

A vaccine containing diphtheria toxoid, a chemically inactivated toxin that stimulates antibodies against diphtheria toxin. It is usually given in combination vaccines with protection against tetanus and pertussis.

Disease-Modifying Antirheumatic Drug

A medicine used for inflammatory rheumatic diseases to reduce disease activity and help prevent lasting joint or organ damage, rather than only relieving symptoms. Different types are chosen according to the disease, severity, other conditions, and monitoring needs.

Alternate Names:
DMARD; DMARDs; Disease-Modifying Antirheumatic Drugs

Disulfiram

A medicine used as an adjunct for alcohol-use disorder that inhibits aldehyde dehydrogenase and can cause an unpleasant reaction if alcohol is consumed.

Diuretic

A medicine that helps the kidneys remove extra salt and water in urine. It can treat swelling, high blood pressure, heart failure, or selected kidney and liver conditions but may disturb salts or cause dehydration.

Alternate Names:
Diuretics; Water Pills

Doctor Of Osteopathic Medicine

A physician who has completed an accredited osteopathic medical degree and residency training and is licensed to diagnose, prevent, and treat disease.

Drug Administration Route

The pathway by which a medicine enters the body, such as oral, intravenous, intramuscular, inhaled, topical, or subcutaneous administration.

Drug Allergies

See *Drug Allergy*.

Drug Allergy

An immune-mediated hypersensitivity reaction to a medicine. It can range from a limited rash to anaphylaxis and is distinct from predictable side effects and nonimmune intolerance.

Drug Antagonism

An interaction where one drug blocks or decreases the effectiveness of another, such as when an antidote blocks a poison.

Drug Bioavailability

The fraction of an administered dose that reaches the systemic circulation unchanged. It depends on the route, absorption, and first-pass metabolism; intravenous administration has 100% bioavailability.

Drug Classification Systems

Systems that group medicines according to properties such as their chemical structure, mechanism of action, therapeutic use, or effects on the body.

Drug Clearance

The rate at which the body removes a medicine from the bloodstream, expressed as the volume of plasma cleared of the medicine per unit time. The liver and kidneys are major routes of clearance.

Drug Dependence

Physical adaptation to a drug such that reducing or stopping it can cause withdrawal symptoms. Dependence is distinct from addiction, which involves compulsive use despite harm; some medicines cause physical dependence without addiction.

Drug-Drug Interactions

See *Drug Interaction*.

Drug-Eluting Balloon (Vascular)

A vascular balloon catheter that delivers a medicine to the vessel wall during dilation, without leaving a permanent implant.

Alternate Names:
Vascular

Drug Emulsion

A liquid medicine in which droplets of one liquid are dispersed in another liquid that does not normally mix with it. Formulation ingredients help maintain the emulsion's stability.

Drug Eruption

A skin eruption caused by a medication, ranging from a mild morbilliform rash to severe reactions such as Stevens–Johnson syndrome or toxic epidermal necrolysis.

Alternate Names:
Drug Eruptions

Drug-Facilitated Sexual Assault

Non-consensual sexual contact occurring when an individual is incapacitated due to the intoxicating, sedative, or memory-impairing effects of alcohol, sedatives, or illicit substances.

Drug Hypersensitivity Reactions

Immune-mediated adverse reactions to medicines. They may be immediate or delayed and can range from a mild rash to severe systemic illness.

Drug Hypersensitivity Syndrome

A serious delayed reaction to a medicine, usually beginning two to eight weeks after it is started. It may cause fever, widespread rash, facial swelling, enlarged lymph nodes, abnormal blood cells, and injury to the liver, kidneys, lungs, or heart.

Drug-Induced Autoimmunity

An immune reaction caused by a medicine in which the body attacks its own tissues. It may resemble lupus, cause joint pain, fever, rash, or organ inflammation, and often improves after the responsible medicine is stopped under medical guidance.

Drug-Induced Diarrhea

Diarrhea caused by a medicine or drug interaction. Common causes include antibiotics, laxatives, metformin, and medicines that alter intestinal motility.

Drug-Induced Immune Hemolytic Anemia

An uncommon immune reaction triggered by certain medications where drug-dependent antibodies bind to red blood cells, causing premature erythrocyte destruction (hemolysis) and anemia.

Drug Induced Liver Disease

Liver tissue injury or inflammation caused by medications, herbal supplements, or toxic chemicals, manifesting as impaired bile flow (cholestasis), hepatitis, or acute liver failure.

Drug-Induced Low Blood Sugar

Low blood glucose caused by a medicine, most often insulin or an insulin secretagogue. Symptoms may include sweating, tremor, confusion, seizure, or loss of consciousness.

Drug-Induced Pulmonary Disease

Lung tissue damage or inflammatory injury resulting from medication exposure, presenting as interstitial pneumonitis, pulmonary fibrosis, fluid accumulation (pulmonary edema), or bronchospasm.

Drug-Induced Thrombocytopenia

A low platelet count caused by a medicine through immune destruction, reduced production, or other mechanisms, increasing bleeding risk.

Drug-Induced Tremor

Tremor caused or worsened by a medicine, stimulant, or toxin. Assessment considers timing, dose, other causes, and whether the medicine can be changed.

Drug Interaction

A change in a medicine's effect or concentration caused by another medicine, food, supplement, or disease.

Alternate Names:
Drug-Drug Interaction

Drug Metabolism

The enzymatic conversion of medicines into metabolites, mainly in the liver but also in the intestine, kidneys, lungs, and other tissues.

Drug Metabolism Pharmacogenomics

The study of how inherited genetic differences change the way a person breaks down medicines. This information can sometimes help clinicians choose a safer or more effective medicine or dose.

Drug Overdose

Harm caused by exposure to more medicine than the body can safely tolerate, including an excessive dose or an error in route or timing. Effects range from mild symptoms to seizures, organ damage, or respiratory failure.

Drug Packaging

The container, labeling, and protective materials used to preserve a medicine and support correct identification, storage, and use.

Drug, Prescription

See *Prescription Drug*.

Drug Resistance

The ability of microorganisms, cancer cells, or parasites to survive and proliferate despite exposure to drugs that were previously effective.

Drug, Sulfa

A sulfonamide drug; some are antibacterial medicines, while others are used as diuretics or for other indications, and sulfonamide reactions vary by drug and patient.

Drug Therapeutics

The use of medicines to prevent, diagnose, or treat disease while balancing expected benefit and potential harm.

Drug Tolerance

A reduced response to a medicine after repeated use, so the same dose produces less effect. Tolerance does not necessarily mean that a higher dose is needed or appropriate.

Drug Toxicity

Harmful effects caused by a medicine or its metabolites. Toxicity may result from excessive exposure, accumulation, interactions, or an unpredictable individual reaction.

Drug Use First Aid

Initial emergency supportive care provided to stabilize an individual experiencing acute substance toxicity, severe intoxication, or drug overdose until emergency medical personnel arrive.

Drug Vehicle

An inactive substance or carrier used to deliver an active drug ingredient in a formulation.

Drug Withdrawal

A clinically significant syndrome or return of symptoms caused by abrupt reduction or cessation of a drug after physiologic adaptation or dependence has developed. Tapering is required for some medications to reduce withdrawal and rebound effects.

DTaP Vaccine

A vaccine against diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis (whooping cough), given mainly to infants and young children in a multi-dose series. It reduces severe illness, complications, and spread; schedules vary by country.

Eflornithine

A medicine that slows cell growth by blocking an enzyme needed to make certain cell components. A skin cream can reduce unwanted facial hair; an intravenous form has been used for selected African trypanosome infections.

Enzyme Inhibitor

A substance that slows or blocks an enzyme, a protein that helps chemical reactions occur in the body. Medicines use this action to change processes such as blood pressure, inflammation, infection, hormone production, or cancer-cell growth.

Estrogen Inhibitor

A medicine that reduces estrogen production or blocks estrogen's effects. It may treat selected hormone-sensitive cancers or other conditions; side effects can include hot flashes, bone loss, joint symptoms, or blood clots.

Etidronate

A bisphosphonate medicine that slows the break-

down and rebuilding of bone. It is used selectively for some disorders of abnormal bone remodeling; treatment depends on the condition and can affect the stomach, kidneys, or minerals.

Evidence-Based Medicine

The use of reliable research together with clinical expertise and the patient's values and circumstances to make healthcare decisions. It supports, but does not replace, discussion between patient and clinician.

Expectorant

A medicine intended to loosen or thin mucus so it is easier to cough up. Benefit varies with the cause of cough and the product; persistent breathlessness, fever, chest pain, or blood needs medical assessment.

Extensively Drug-Resistant TB

Tuberculosis caused by bacteria that meet the definition of multidrug- or rifampicin-resistant TB and are also resistant to any fluoroquinolone and at least one of the medicines bedaquiline or linezolid.

Fentanyl

A potent synthetic opioid analgesic used for severe pain and anesthesia. It can cause respiratory depression, sedation, constipation, nausea, tolerance, dependence, and fatal overdose, especially when combined with alcohol or other sedatives.

Fertility Agent

A medicine or biologic intervention intended to improve the chance of conception by inducing ovulation, supporting sperm production, or treating a reproductive mechanism.

Fidaxomicin

A narrow-spectrum oral macrocyclic antibiotic used to treat Clostridioides difficile infection. It has minimal systemic absorption and reduces disruption of normal intestinal flora compared with many alternatives, but recurrence can still occur.

Filgrastim

A recombinant granulocyte colony-stimulating factor that increases production and release of neutrophils from bone marrow. It is used to reduce or treat selected forms of chemotherapy-related neutropenia; bone pain and rare splenic complications can occur.

Finasteride

A medicine that lowers the conversion of testosterone to dihydrotestosterone. It can shrink an enlarged prostate and help some types of hair loss but may reduce libido, affect sexual function, or alter prostate-test results.

Fixed Drug Eruption

A medicine-related skin reaction that returns in the same place whenever the person takes the responsible medicine. It may appear as a sharply outlined red or dark patch, sometimes with a blister or sore, and can leave lasting discoloration.

Fluticasone

A corticosteroid available in inhaled, nasal, topical, and other formulations to reduce inflammation. Adverse effects depend on route and may include local irritation, oral candidiasis, skin thinning, adrenal suppression, or growth effects with prolonged exposure.

Food-Drug Interaction

A change in how a medicine works or is absorbed because of food, drink, nutrients, or supplements. Examples include grapefruit affecting some medicines, vitamin K changing warfarin's effect, and calcium reducing absorption of some antibiotics.

Forensic Medicine

Application of medical knowledge to legal questions, including injury interpretation, cause of death, toxicology, identification, sexual assault evaluation, and documentation.

Forensic Medicine (Legal Medicine)

Branch of medicine that applies medical, biological, and scientific knowledge to legal questions and the

administration of justice.

Alternate Names:
Legal Medicine

Foscarnet

An intravenous antiviral agent used for selected cytomegalovirus or herpesvirus infections, especially when resistance or intolerance limits other treatment. Important toxicities include kidney injury and disturbances of calcium, magnesium, potassium, or phosphate.

Furosemide

A diuretic that makes the kidneys remove more salt and water in urine. It treats swelling and some blood-pressure or heart conditions but may cause dehydration, abnormal body salts, kidney problems, or hearing damage.

Ganglionic Blocker

A medicine that interrupts nerve signals at switching points controlling automatic body functions. It can affect blood pressure, heart rate, digestion, sweating, vision, and bladder function, so these medicines are rarely used clinically.

Generic Drug

A medicine equivalent to a brand-name medicine in active ingredient, strength, dosage form, and intended use, usually sold under a nonproprietary name.

Alternate Names:
Generic medicine

Generic Medicine

A medicine with the same active ingredient, strength, form, route, and intended effect as an approved reference medicine. It may look different or have different inactive ingredients but must meet regulatory quality and performance requirements.

Generic Name, Drug

The official nonproprietary name of a medicine's active ingredient, used consistently across manufacturers and countries. It identifies the medicine itself rather than a company's brand name and helps prevent confusion when products have different trade names.

Genomic Medicine

Use of a person's genetic or genomic information to guide disease diagnosis, risk assessment, prevention, or treatment.

Geriatric Medicine

The medical specialty focused on the health, function, diseases, medications, and goals of older adults, often using comprehensive and coordinated care.

Growth Inhibitor

A medicine or biological substance that slows or stops cell growth. In cancer treatment, it may block cell division or a growth signal, but it can also affect healthy cells and cause side effects.

Haemophilus Vaccine

A vaccine that protects against serious disease caused by Haemophilus influenzae type b, including meningitis, pneumonia, and bloodstream infection. It is given mainly in infancy according to the recommended immunization schedule.

Hepatic Drug Metabolism

The liver changes medicines into forms that the body can use or remove. This may stop a medicine's effect, activate a medicine that works after conversion, or produce a harmful product; age, illness, genetics, and other medicines can alter the process.

Hepatitis B Vaccine

A recombinant vaccine that prevents hepatitis B infection, which can cause chronic liver disease, cirrhosis, and liver cancer. It is given in a series beginning at birth in many schedules; infants exposed at birth may also need hepatitis B immune globulin.

Hepatitis B Vaccine (Birth Dose)

A dose of hepatitis B vaccine administered shortly after birth to induce early active immunity and prevent transmission of the hepatitis B virus from

mother to infant during delivery.

Alternate Names:
Birth Dose

HER2 Inhibitor

A targeted cancer treatment that blocks signaling through human epidermal growth factor receptor 2 in cancers with HER2 overexpression or amplification.

High Blood Pressure - Medicine-Related

Hypertension caused or worsened by a medicine or substance, such as NSAIDs, steroids, decongestants, stimulants, oral contraceptives, or immunosuppressants; review and substitution may improve control.

Histamine-2 Receptor Antagonist

A medicine that reduces stomach-acid production by blocking histamine signals in the stomach. It may treat reflux, indigestion, or ulcers; headache, diarrhea, confusion, and medicine interactions can occur.

Hormone Inhibitor

A medicine or biologic that blocks hormone synthesis, release, receptor binding, or downstream signaling, used in selected endocrine disorders and hormone-sensitive cancers.

HPV Vaccine

A vaccine that prevents infection with human papillomavirus types that cause several cancers and genital warts. It is routinely offered in early adolescence, can start from age 9, and may require two or three doses depending on age and immune status; it does not treat existing HPV infection.

Hypoglycemic Agent

A medicine that lowers blood glucose, including insulin, insulin secretagogues, insulin sensitizers, incretin-based drugs, and sodium–glucose cotransporter inhibitors; choice depends on diabetes type and patient risks.

Hypolipidemic Agent

A medicine that lowers fats in the blood, such as LDL cholesterol or triglycerides. It helps reduce cardiovascular risk when combined with appropriate diet, activity, and treatment of other risk factors.

Immunosuppressant

A medicine that reduces immune-system activity. It may be used to prevent organ transplant rejection or treat autoimmune and inflammatory diseases; effects and infection risks vary by medicine and dose.

Immunosuppressant Drug

A medicine that reduces immune-system activity, often to prevent transplant rejection or treat autoimmune disease.

Immunosuppressive Drug

A drug that suppresses immune responses, used for organ transplantation, graft-versus-host disease, and autoimmune/inflammatory diseases.

Inactivated Polio Vaccine

An injected vaccine made from killed polioviruses. It trains the immune system to prevent poliomyelitis and is used in routine childhood immunization programs; the schedule and use of other polio vaccines vary by country.

Influenza Vaccine

A seasonal vaccine that reduces the risk of influenza and its complications. It is updated as needed and is offered each year to most people from early infancy; some young children need two doses in their first vaccinated season, according to local recommendations.

Inotrope

A medication that alters the force or strength of myocardial contraction. Positive inotropes increase cardiac muscle contractility, enhancing blood circulation and blood pressure in acute heart failure or shock.

Intensive Care Medicine

The medical specialty dedicated to the continuous monitoring, life support, and advanced treatment of patients with acute, life-threatening organ dysfunction, critical trauma, or severe post-surgical complications.

Japanese Encephalitis Vaccine

A vaccine that protects against Japanese encephalitis, a mosquito-borne viral infection of the central nervous system. Vaccine type, schedule, and eligibility depend on age, destination or exposure risk, and local recommendations.

Laxative

See *Laxatives*.

Legal Medicine

The application of medical knowledge to legal questions, including forensic examination, injury assessment, death investigation, and issues of capacity or consent.

Liquid Medication Administration

The delivery of pharmaceutical agents formulated in liquid solution, suspension, or syrup form, particularly useful for pediatric patients and individuals who have difficulty swallowing solid tablets.

Local Anesthetic

A medicine that temporarily numbs a specific area without usually causing loss of consciousness. It blocks pain signals in nearby nerves and is used for procedures, dental work, wound repair, and some forms of regional pain relief.

Alternate Names:
Local Anesthetics

Luteinizing Hormone-Releasing Hormone Agonist

A medicine that first stimulates and then, with continued use, suppresses signals from the pituitary gland that control the ovaries or testes. It is used for selected cancers, endometriosis, fibroids, and puberty disorders.

Alternate Names:
GnRH agonist; LHRH agonist

Macrolide Antibiotic

An antibiotic of the macrolide class that binds the bacterial 50S ribosomal subunit and usually inhibits protein synthesis; activity and resistance vary by organism and drug.

Malaria Vaccine

A vaccine intended to reduce malaria caused by *Plasmodium* parasites, especially *P. falciparum*; the RTS,S/AS01 and R21/Matrix-M vaccines are used in recommended childhood immunization programs in some endemic settings, alongside other preventive measures.

MAO Inhibitor

A class of medications that block monoamine oxidase enzymes, preventing the breakdown of neurotransmitters such as serotonin, norepinephrine, and dopamine in the nervous system.

Measles-Rubella Vaccine

A combined live attenuated vaccine containing measles and rubella antigens without the mumps component, widely used in countries where mumps is not a significant public health burden, including India's Universal Immunization Schedule.

Measles Vaccine

Measles vaccine is a live attenuated vaccine that induces active immunity against measles virus. It is usually given as part of the measles–mumps–rubella (MMR) or measles–mumps–rubella–varicella (MMRV) vaccine.

Medication

A substance or biological product used to prevent, diagnose, treat, or control a disease or symptom. Medicines may be prescribed, bought without a prescription, applied to the body, inhaled, swallowed, or given by injection.

Medication Adherence

The extent to which a patient's medication-taking behavior corresponds with the agreed treatment plan. Adherence is influenced by understanding, adverse effects, cost, access, regimen complexity, beliefs, and cognitive or social factors.

Medication Adverse-Effect Profile

The clinically relevant pattern of predictable pharmacologic effects and harmful reactions associated with a medication. It includes common dose-related effects, serious rare events, organ-specific toxicity, interactions, and monitoring requirements.

Medication Cascade

A prescribing sequence in which an adverse drug effect is misinterpreted as a new medical condition and another drug is prescribed to treat it. Recognizing cascades is an important goal of medication reconciliation and deprescribing.

Medication Deprescribing

A planned, supervised process of reducing the dose or stopping a medicine when its current or future harms outweigh its benefits or when treatment goals change. Tapering may be required to prevent withdrawal or rebound disease.

Medication Error

A preventable event that may cause or lead to inappropriate medication use or patient harm while the medication is in the control of a healthcare professional, patient, or consumer. Errors can occur during prescribing, transcribing, dispensing, administration, or monitoring.

Medication Management

The systematic process of optimizing pharmacotherapy to achieve therapeutic goals while minimizing adverse effects, encompassing prescribing, dispensing, administration, monitoring, and deprescribing.

Medication Overuse Headaches

Frequent headaches caused or worsened by regular overuse of headache medicines.

Alternate Names:
Rebound Headache

Medication Reconciliation

A structured process of obtaining and comparing the most accurate medication list with current prescriptions at transitions of care. It identifies omissions, duplications, incorrect doses, interactions, and unintended changes.

Medication Review

A structured clinical evaluation of an individual's complete medication regimen to ensure that each medicine is clinically indicated, effective, safe, and free of adverse drug interactions.

Medication Safety

Practices that reduce medication errors and prevent avoidable harm during prescribing, dispensing, administration, and use.

Medication Side Effects

Unintended harmful responses to medications occurring at standard doses, ranging from mild (nausea, rash, dry mouth) to severe (anaphylaxis, Stevens-Johnson syndrome, QT prolongation, hepatotoxicity).

Meningococcal Vaccine

Conjugate vaccine (MenACWY) and serogroup B vaccine (MenB) given at 11-12 years with booster at 16 years. Protects against Neisseria meningitidis, causing meningitis and septicemia. MenACWY booster at 16 years covers the high-risk period for serogroup C and Y disease.

Mineralocorticoid Receptor Antagonist

A medicine that blocks aldosterone, a hormone that makes the body retain salt and water. It is used for selected heart failure, high blood pressure, and hormone disorders but can raise blood potassium and worsen kidney problems.

MMR Vaccine

A live attenuated vaccine against measles, mumps,

and rubella. It is given according to the immunization schedule and is generally avoided during pregnancy and in people with certain severe immune deficiencies.

Molecular Medicine

Molecular medicine applies molecular and cellular biology to understand, diagnose, prevent, and treat disease. It includes genomics, precision oncology, molecular biomarkers, targeted therapy, and other mechanism-based approaches.

Monoamine Oxidase Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks monoamine oxidase, an enzyme that breaks down certain brain chemicals. It can treat selected depression or neurologic disorders but has important interactions with other medicines and some foods.

MRNA Vaccine

A vaccine that gives cells temporary instructions to make a harmless piece of a germ. The immune system learns to recognize that piece and respond later; the messenger RNA does not enter the cell nucleus or change DNA.

Alternate Names:
MRNA Vaccines; Messenger RNA Vaccine; Messenger RNA Vaccines

Multi-Drug Resistance

Multidrug resistance is resistance of a microorganism, cancer, or other disease process to multiple drugs that would otherwise be active. Mechanisms include target changes, drug inactivation, reduced uptake, efflux, and altered repair or survival pathways.

Multidrug-Resistant Extensively Drug-Resistant TB

See *Multidrug-Resistant Tuberculosis* and *Extensively Drug-Resistant TB*.

Neuropathy Secondary To Drugs

Peripheral nerve damage caused by exposure to medications or chemical toxins, typically resulting in symmetrical numbness, tingling, burning pain, or muscle weakness in the hands and feet.

Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drug

A medicine that inhibits cyclooxygenase enzymes and reduces prostaglandin production, producing analgesic, anti-inflammatory, and fever-reducing effects. NSAIDs can cause gastrointestinal, kidney, cardiovascular, or other adverse effects.

NSAIDs

See *Nonsteroidal Anti-Inflammatory Drug*.

Occupational Medicine

The medical specialty concerned with the effects of work on health, prevention of work-related illness and injury, and safe return to work.

Opioid Analgesics

Strong pain medicines that act on opioid receptors in the brain, spinal cord, and other tissues. They can relieve severe pain but may cause sleepiness, constipation, dependence, and dangerously slow breathing or overdose.

Opioid Antagonist

A medicine that blocks opioid receptors and can reverse opioid effects such as respiratory depression. Naloxone is a commonly used example.

Oral Hypoglycemic

A medicine taken by mouth to lower blood glucose. Oral glucose-lowering medicines act through different mechanisms and are used mainly to treat type 2 diabetes.

Oral Medicine

Specialty diagnosing oral mucosal diseases, dental causes of facial pain, oral manifestations of systemic disease.

Oral Polio Vaccine

A live attenuated poliovirus vaccine administered by mouth. Its formulation and use depend on the public-health program and circulating poliovirus strains; it has played an important role in polio

control.

Orphan Drug

A medicine designated for treating, preventing, or diagnosing a rare disease under a jurisdiction's orphan-drug rules. Criteria vary; in the United States, FDA designation generally applies to conditions affecting fewer than 200,000 people, with a cost-recovery exception.

Over-The-Counter Drug

See *Over-The-Counter (OTC) Drug*.

Over-The-Counter (OTC) Drug

A medicine sold without a prescription for uses and doses described on its label. "Over the counter" does not mean risk-free; incorrect use, interactions, or excessive doses can still cause serious harm.

P2Y12 Inhibitor

A class of antiplatelet medications that block ADP P2Y12 receptors on platelet surfaces, preventing platelet activation and aggregation to reduce the risk of arterial blood clots.

Palifermin

A laboratory-made form of a natural growth factor that helps mouth and throat lining cells repair themselves. It is used in selected people receiving intensive treatment before blood-forming stem-cell transplantation to reduce severe mouth sores.

Palonosetron

A long-acting anti-nausea medicine that blocks serotonin signals involved in vomiting. It is used to prevent nausea and vomiting from chemotherapy or surgery; headache, constipation, and rare heart-rhythm changes can occur.

Parasympatholytic

A medicine that blocks some signals of the parasympathetic nervous system. It may widen the airways, relax the bladder, reduce motion sickness, or speed a slow heartbeat, but can cause dry mouth, blurred vision, constipation, urinary retention, or confusion.

Parasympathomimetic

A medication or chemical that stimulates the parasympathetic nervous system, mimicking acetylcholine to slow heart rate, stimulate digestive secretions, and constrict the pupils.

Paroxetine

Paroxetine is a selective serotonin-reuptake inhibitor used for depression, anxiety disorders, obsessive-compulsive disorder, PTSD, and some other conditions; sexual dysfunction, withdrawal symptoms, serotonin syndrome, and pregnancy-related risks require consideration.

Pediatric Nuclear Medicine

A branch of medical imaging that uses small, weight-adjusted amounts of radioactive tracers to evaluate organ function, bone development, and disease processes in infants and children.

Pefloxacin

A fluoroquinolone antibiotic that blocks bacterial enzymes needed to copy and repair DNA. Its use is limited by resistance and potentially serious effects involving tendons, nerves, the heart, and the nervous system.

PEG

An abbreviation for polyethylene glycol, a polymer used as an osmotic laxative and to modify some medicines (PEGylation), or for percutaneous endoscopic gastrostomy, the procedure for placing a feeding tube through the abdominal wall into the stomach. It can also refer to the feeding tube placed by that procedure; spell out the intended meaning.

Pegaspargase

A long-acting enzyme medicine used in combination treatment for some acute lymphoblastic leukemias. It lowers asparagine needed by leukemia cells; allergic reactions, pancreatitis, liver injury, clotting problems, and bleeding are important risks.

Pegfilgrastim

A long-acting growth factor that stimulates the bone marrow to make neutrophils. It helps prevent

infection caused by chemotherapy-related low white-cell counts; bone pain and rare spleen rupture or serious inflammation can occur.

Penicillamine

A medicine that binds certain metals and can also reduce immune activity. It is used selectively for copper overload and some autoimmune or connective-tissue disorders; serious blood, kidney, skin, or allergic reactions can occur.

Pentavalent Vaccine

A combination vaccine that protects against five diseases. Components vary by product; a common childhood formulation contains diphtheria and tetanus toxoids, pertussis antigens, hepatitis B surface antigen, and a conjugate against *Haemophilus influenzae* type b.

Pentobarbital

A barbiturate medicine that depresses brain activity and can cause sedation or control seizures. It has a high risk of slowed breathing, coma, dependence, and fatal overdose, especially with alcohol or other sedatives.

Perioperative Antibiotic Prophylaxis

Administration of an appropriate antimicrobial within a defined interval before incision to reduce infection risk for selected procedures. Choice, timing, redosing, and discontinuation depend on procedure, organisms, patient factors, and local guidance.

Pertussis Vaccine

A vaccine containing selected antigens from Bordetella pertussis, given in combination vaccines to prevent whooping cough and reduce severe disease and transmission.

Pharmaceutical

Relating to medicines, including their development, preparation, manufacture, testing, storage, or use.

Pharmacodynamic Interaction

A drug interaction in which one drug changes the effect of another at its site of action without necessarily changing its concentration. Effects may be additive, synergistic, or antagonistic, such as combined respiratory depression or bleeding risk.

Pharmacokinetic Interaction

A drug interaction that changes absorption, distribution, metabolism, or excretion of another drug, thereby altering its concentration over time. Enzyme inhibition, enzyme induction, transporter effects, and altered gastric pH are common mechanisms.

Phosphodiesterase Inhibitor

A medicine that blocks enzymes which normally break down chemical signals inside cells. Different types relax airways or blood vessels, improve heart pumping, or treat erectile dysfunction; effects and risks depend on the specific type.

Pneumococcal Conjugate Vaccine

A vaccine that joins parts of the pneumococcus bacterium to a carrier protein so the immune system can build lasting protection. It helps prevent pneumonia, meningitis, bloodstream infection, and other disease; product and schedule depend on age and risk.

Pneumococcal Vaccine

A vaccine that protects against selected serotypes of *Streptococcus pneumoniae* (pneumococcus), which can cause pneumonia, meningitis, bloodstream infection, sinusitis, and otitis media. Available products include pneumococcal conjugate vaccines and pneumococcal polysaccharide vaccine; the product and schedule depend on age, previous doses, and medical risk.

Poliovirus Vaccine

A vaccine that trains the immune system to prevent poliovirus infection and paralysis. Inactivated injectable and live oral forms are used in different programs; the schedule and product depend on age, health, and local public-health guidance.

Prazosin

An alpha-1 blocker that relaxes blood vessels and may relax the bladder outlet. It is used for high blood pressure and, in selected patients, trauma-related nightmares or urinary symptoms; dizziness and fainting are most likely after starting or increasing the dose.

Pre-Medication

Medicine given before a procedure, treatment, or exposure to prevent a predictable problem such as pain, nausea, allergy, infection, or anxiety.

Prescription Drug

A medicine that can be dispensed only under an authorized prescriber's order, according to the laws and regulations of the relevant jurisdiction.

Procalcitonin-Guided Antibiotic Therapy

Use of blood procalcitonin measurements, together with examination and other tests, to help decide whether to start or stop antibiotics in selected infections. The result cannot by itself confirm bacterial infection or safely replace clinical judgment.

Prostaglandin Antagonist

A drug that blocks a prostaglandin receptor or pathway, reducing selected prostaglandin-mediated effects such as inflammation, pain, uterine contraction, or gastric secretion.

Protease Inhibitor

An antiviral medicine that blocks a virus enzyme needed to cut newly made proteins into working parts. In HIV treatment, it prevents formation of mature infectious virus and is used with other medicines.

Proton Pump Inhibitor

See *Proton Pump Inhibitors*.

Psychotropic Drug

A medicine that affects brain function and may change mood, thinking, behavior, sleep, or perception. The term includes antidepressants, antipsychotics, mood stabilizers, stimulants, and some medicines for anxiety or sleep.

Psychotropic Medication

See *Psychotropic Drug*.

Rabies Vaccine

A vaccine containing inactivated rabies virus used for preexposure protection or postexposure prophylaxis after a possible rabies exposure, together with wound care and immune globulin when indicated.

Rehabilitation Medicine

Alternate name; see *Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation*.

Alternate Names:
physiatry.

Renal Drug Excretion

Removal of medicines from the body by the kidneys into urine. Kidney disease can slow this process, allowing some medicines to build up and requiring dose changes or closer monitoring.

Renin Inhibitor

A blood-pressure medicine that blocks renin, an enzyme involved in narrowing blood vessels and retaining salt. It lowers blood pressure but can raise potassium, affect kidney function, and harm a developing fetus.

Resistance Antibiotic (Antibiotic Resistance)

Alternate index label for Antibiotic Resistance.

Rock (Drug)

A street term commonly used for crack cocaine, a smokeable form of cocaine. It produces intense, short-lived stimulation but can cause dependence, dangerous heart rhythms, heart attack, stroke, seizures, overheating, or severe agitation.

Scabicide

A medicine applied to the skin or taken by mouth to kill scabies mites. Treatment usually includes

all close household or sexual contacts and washing or isolating recently used clothing and bedding to prevent reinfection.

Selective Serotonin Reuptake Inhibitor

A medicine that increases serotonin signalling between nerve cells by slowing serotonin reuptake. It treats depression and several anxiety-related disorders; nausea, sexual difficulties, withdrawal symptoms, and rarely serotonin toxicity can occur.

SGLT2 Inhibitor

A medicine that makes the kidneys pass more glucose and salt into the urine. It lowers blood sugar and can protect the heart and kidneys in selected people, but may cause dehydration, genital infections, or rarely ketoacidosis.

Skeletal Muscle Relaxant

A medicine that reduces excessive contraction of skeletal muscles. It may relieve short-term muscle spasm or longer-term spasticity, but sleepiness, weakness, dizziness, and impaired breathing can occur with some drugs.

Sleep Drug

A medicine used to help a person fall asleep, stay asleep, or maintain a regular sleep pattern. Benefits and risks vary widely; drowsiness, falls, impaired thinking, dependence, and interactions with alcohol or sedatives are important concerns.

Steroid

A group of chemicals with a characteristic structure. In medicine, steroids include corticosteroids that reduce inflammation and natural or replacement hormones such as cortisol, estrogen, progesterone, and testosterone.

Steroid Abuse

Steroid misuse is non-prescribed or excessive use of corticosteroids or anabolic-androgenic steroids, which can cause endocrine suppression, psychiatric effects, infection, metabolic disease, liver injury, cardiovascular harm, or tissue damage.

Steroid Hormones

Lipid-soluble hormones derived from cholesterol, including cortisol, aldosterone, estrogen, progesterone, and testosterone.

Steroid Injections - Tendon, Bursa, Joint

Injection of a corticosteroid, often with local anesthetic, into or around a joint, bursa, or tendon sheath to reduce inflammation and pain; injections directly into tendons are generally avoided because of rupture risk.

Tamsulosin

Tamsulosin is a selective alpha-1A blocker that relaxes prostate and bladder-neck smooth muscle to improve urinary symptoms of benign prostatic hyperplasia; dizziness, postural hypotension, and ejaculatory dysfunction may occur.

TCAs

Tricyclic antidepressants are medicines that increase the effects of certain brain chemicals. They can treat depression, nerve pain, and some other conditions but may cause sleepiness, dry mouth, constipation, low blood pressure, abnormal heart rhythms, or overdose toxicity.

Tdap Vaccine

A booster vaccine against tetanus, diphtheria, and pertussis, used for adolescent and adult immunization. Schedules vary by country; in the United States it is recommended during each pregnancy, usually at 27–36 weeks, to transfer pertussis antibodies to the infant.

Terazosin

An alpha-blocking medicine that relaxes the prostate and blood vessels. It can improve urine flow in prostate enlargement and lower blood pressure, but dizziness or fainting may occur, especially after the first dose or dose increases.

Therapeutic Drug Levels

The range of medicine concentrations in blood associated with benefit while limiting toxicity for a particular drug. A measured level must be inter-

preted with the dose, timing, symptoms, kidney or liver function, and the person's response.

Thrombolytic

A medicine that helps dissolve a blood clot by changing plasminogen into plasmin, which breaks down fibrin. It may be used urgently for selected strokes, heart attacks, or other life-threatening clots when benefits outweigh bleeding risk.

Thrombolytic Drugs For Heart Attack

Intravenous clot-dissolving medications that activate plasminogen into plasmin to break down fibrin clots obstructing coronary arteries, restoring blood flow to the heart muscle during an acute myocardial infarction.

Transfusion Medicine

The medical specialty that selects, prepares, tests, and gives blood or blood components such as red cells, platelets, plasma, and cryoprecipitate. It includes matching, preventing transfusion reactions, and monitoring patients.

Travel Medicine

Medical care concerned with prevention and treatment of health problems related to travel.

Tricyclic Antidepressant Overdose

Acute poisoning from tricyclic antidepressant medications, leading to severe anticholinergic toxicity, altered mental status, seizures, hypotension, and life-threatening cardiac conduction delays.

Tumor Necrosis Factor Inhibitor

A biological medicine that blocks tumor-necrosis factor, an immune signal involved in inflammation. It treats selected arthritis, psoriasis, and bowel diseases but can increase serious infection risk, so screening and monitoring are important.

Tyrosine Kinase Inhibitor

A targeted medicine that blocks enzymes carrying growth signals inside cells. It can slow cancers driven by abnormal signaling, but side effects vary and may include diarrhea, skin changes, liver injury, high blood pressure, or heart problems.

Uricosuric Agent

A medicine that increases renal excretion of uric acid, lowering serum urate in selected patients with gout. Adequate kidney function and hydration are important, and urinary uric-acid stones may be a concern.

Urine Drug Screen

A preliminary urine test that looks for selected medicines or recreational drugs and their breakdown products. Results can be falsely positive or negative and may need confirmation with a more specific laboratory test.

Uterotonic

A medicine that makes the uterus contract. It is used under medical supervision to start or strengthen labor, prevent or treat heavy bleeding after birth, or complete selected pregnancy-related procedures; excessive contraction can harm the mother or fetus.

Vaccine Adjuvant

A substance added to some vaccines to enhance and prolong the immune response to the antigen. Examples include aluminum salts and newer adjuvant systems.

Vaccine Therapy

Treatment that uses a vaccine to stimulate an immune response against a disease. It may prevent infection or, in selected cancer treatments, help the immune system recognize abnormal cells; its benefits depend on the specific vaccine and condition.

Varicella Vaccine

A live attenuated vaccine that prevents or reduces the severity of chickenpox. The number and timing of doses depend on age, vaccination history, immune status, pregnancy, and local recommendations. It is generally avoided during pregnancy and in people with certain immune deficiencies.

Xanthine Oxidase Inhibitor

A medicine that lowers uric-acid production by blocking an enzyme involved in breaking down substances from cells and food. It is used mainly to prevent gout attacks and, in selected cases, complications from rapid cancer-cell breakdown.

Brand Medicines

Medical Word Elements

Word element	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Ab-	A medical prefix meaning away from, off, or separating from,	abduction (movement away from the midline) and ablation (removal or destruction of tissue)
Acou-	A combining form meaning hearing or sound,	acoustics and acoumeter
Acro-	Acro- is a medical word element meaning extremity, tip, or highest part,	acromegaly and acrocyanosis
Acu-	A word element meaning sharp or pointed,	acute and acupuncture
Ad-	A medical prefix meaning toward, to, or near,	adduction (movement toward the midline) and adrenal (near the kidney)
Aden-	A combining form meaning gland or glandular tissue,	adenitis and adenoma
Adeno-	A combining form referring to a gland or glandular tissue,	adenovirus, adenoid, and adenocarcinoma
Aer-, Aero-	A combining form meaning air or gas,	aerobic, aerosol, and aerophagia
Alb-	A prefix derived from the Latin albus, meaning white,	albino and albinism
Amyl-	A combining form referring to starch,	amylase
Amylo-	A combining form referring to starch-like material or amyloid protein,	amyloidosis and amyloidoma
An-	A prefix meaning without, lacking, or not,	anoxia, anesthesia, and anencephaly
Aniso-	A combining form meaning unequal or dissimilar,	anisocytosis and anisometropia
Antero-	A combining form meaning front or anterior,	anteroposterior and anterolateral
Anti-	A prefix meaning against or opposing,	antibiotic and anticoagulant
Arthro-	A combining form meaning joint,	arthritis and arthroscopy
Bi-	A prefix meaning two or twice,	bilateral and bicuspid
Bio-	A combining form meaning life or living organisms,	biochemistry and biopsy
Brachy-	A combining form meaning short,	brachycephaly and brachydactyly
Cephal-	A combining form meaning head,	cephalic and cephalalgia
Cholangi-	A combining form meaning bile duct,	cholangitis and cholangiography

Word element	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Circum-	A prefix meaning around,	circumoral and circumcision
Colpo-	A combining form meaning vagina,	colposcopy and colpotomy
Cranio-	A combining form meaning skull,	craniotomy and craniosynostosis
Cyto-	A combining form meaning cell,	cytology and cytotoxic
Dacryo-	A combining form meaning tear or tear duct,	dacryocystitis and dacryostenosis
Dactyl-, -dactyl	A combining form meaning finger or toe; -dactyl is a suffix,	polydactyly and brachydactyly
Dextro-	A combining form meaning right or toward the right,	dextrocardia and dextroposition
Di-	A prefix meaning two or twice,	diplopia and diplegia
Dia-	A prefix with meanings including through, across, or complete, depending on the word,	dialysis and diagnosis
Disto-	A combining form meaning distal or far from a point of attachment,	distobuccal
Dys-	A prefix meaning abnormal, difficult, painful, or impaired,	dysphagia (difficulty swallowing) and dysuria (painful urination)
Entero-	A combining form meaning intestine or bowel,	enteropathy and enteroscopy
Epi-	A prefix meaning on, upon, or above,	epidermis and epigastric
Extra-	A prefix meaning outside or beyond,	extraocular and extracellular
Gyne-	A combining form meaning woman or female,	gynecology
Hem-, Hema-, Hemat-, Hemato-, Hemo-	Word elements meaning blood; British spellings include haem-, haemato-, and haemo-,	hematology, hematoma, and hemoglobin
Hemi-	A prefix meaning half or one side,	hemiplegia and hemithorax
Hepat-	A combining form meaning liver,	hepatic and hepatocellular
Hepato-	A combining form meaning liver,	hepatobiliary and hepatomegaly
Hetero-	A prefix meaning different, other, or unequal,	heterozygous and heterogeneous
Histo-	A combining form meaning tissue,	histology and histopathology
Homo-	A prefix meaning same or alike,	homozygous and homologous
Hyper-	A prefix meaning excessive, above normal, or increased,	hyperglycemia and hypertension
Hypo-	A prefix meaning below, deficient, reduced, or less than normal,	hypoglycemia and hypothermia
Iatr-	A combining form meaning medical treatment or physician,	iatrogenic and iatrology
Infra-	A prefix meaning below or beneath,	infrapatellar and infraorbital
Intra-	A prefix meaning within or inside,	intraocular and intravenous
Iso-	A prefix meaning equal, same, or uniform,	isotonic and isometric
Juxta-	A prefix meaning next to, beside, or adjoining,	juxtaglomerular
Kerato-	A combining form relating to the cornea or to horny or keratinized tissue,	keratitis and keratosis

Word element	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Leuk-	A combining form meaning white, especially in terms relating to white blood cells,	leukocyte
Leuko-	A combining form meaning white,	leukoderma or leukopenia
Levo-	A prefix meaning left or turning to the left, especially in spatial or chemical descriptions,	levocardia and levorotatory
Lieno-	A combining form meaning relating to the spleen	lienorenal and lienectomy
Lipo-	A combining form meaning relating to fat or lipids	lipoma and lipoprotein
Litho-	A combining form meaning stone,	lithotripsy and nephrolithiasis
Macro-	A prefix meaning large or on a large scale,	macrocytic (involving large cells)
Mega-	A combining form meaning large or greatly enlarged,	megacolon and megakaryocyte
Melan-	A combining form meaning black or dark, especially referring to melanin,	melanoma and melanocyte
Mes-, Meso-	Combining forms meaning middle,	mesencephalon, mesoderm, and mesothelioma
Micro-	A combining form meaning small,	microscopy and microcephaly
Myc-, Myco-	Combining forms meaning fungus,	mycosis and mycology
Myel-	A combining form referring to bone marrow or the spinal cord,	myelitis and myelopathy
Myo-	A combining form meaning muscle,	myopathy and myocarditis
Naso-	A combining form meaning nose,	nasogastric and nasopharyngeal
Neo-	A prefix meaning new or recently formed,	neoplasm and neonatal
Nephro-	A combining form meaning kidney,	nephritis and nephrectomy
Oligo-	A prefix meaning few or scanty,	oliguria and oligospermia
Onco-	A combining form relating to tumors or cancer	oncology and oncogenesis
Onycho-	A combining form meaning nail,	onychomycosis and onycholysis
Ortho-	A word element meaning straight or upright; in orthopedics it refers to correcting deformities,	orthostatic and orthopedics
Osteo-	A combining form meaning bone,	osteomyelitis and osteoporosis
Ot-, Oto-	Combining forms meaning ear,	otitis, otalgia, and otoscope
Oxy-	A word element referring to oxygen or, in some terms, sharpness,	oxygen and oxyhemoglobin
Pachy-	A combining form meaning thick or thickness,	pachyonychia, pachyderma, and pachycephaly
Para-	A prefix with meanings including beside, near, beyond, or abnormal; the sense varies among established terms,	parathyroid, paranasal, and paraesthesia
Patho-	A combining form meaning disease,	pathology and pathogenesis
Peri-	A prefix meaning around or surrounding,	pericardium and periosteum
Phago-	A combining form meaning eating or swallowing,	phagocytosis and phagocyte
Phlebo-	A combining form meaning vein,	phlebitis, phlebectomy, and phlebography
Pneumo-	A combining form referring to air, gas, or the lungs,	pneumothorax and pneumonia
Poly-	A prefix meaning many or much,	polyuria and polyneuropathy

Word element	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Post-	A prefix meaning after,	postoperative, postpartum, and postprandial
Pre-	A prefix meaning before,	prenatal and preoperative
Pro-	A prefix meaning before, forward, or in favor of, depending on the word,	prognosis and prolactin
Pseudo-	A prefix meaning false or resembling but not truly,	pseudocyst and pseudarthrosis
Retro-	A prefix meaning backward or behind,	retroperitoneal and retrosternal
Salpingo-	A combining form meaning fallopian tube,	salpingitis and salpingectomy
Sarco-	A combining form meaning flesh,	sarcoma and sarcoidosis
Schizo-	A combining form meaning split or divided; in schizophrenia it does not mean "split personality,"	schizophrenia and schizoid
Scler-, Sclero-	Combining forms meaning hard,	sclerosis, scleritis, and scleroderma
Sub-	A prefix meaning under or below,	subcutaneous and subdural
Super-	A combining form meaning above, excessive, or superior	superinfection and supernumerary
Supra-	A combining form meaning above or beyond	suprarenal and suprapubic
Syn-	A combining form meaning together, with, or joined	syndactyly and synovitis
Teno-	A combining form relating to a tendon	tenosynovitis and tenodesis
Thermo-	A combining form relating to heat or temperature	thermoregulation and thermotherapy
Toco-, Toko-	Combining forms meaning childbirth or labor,	tocolysis and tokodynamometry
Tomo-	A combining form meaning slice or section,	tomography and tomographic
Trans-	A prefix meaning across, through, or from one side to another,	transdermal and transcatheter
Tricho-	A combining form meaning hair,	trichoscopy and trichotillomania
Tympano-	A combining form meaning eardrum,	tympanoplasty and tympanometry
Xanth-, Xantho-	Combining forms meaning yellow,	xanthoma, xanthelasma, and xanthopsia
Xeno-	A combining form meaning foreign or from another species,	xenograft and xenotransplantation
Xero-	Xero- is a medical word element meaning dry or dryness,	xeroderma, xerophthalmia, and xerostomia

Complete reference tables

These categorized tables reproduce the prefix reference structure from the Pressbooks resource cited below. Examples are retained as learning aids; the meaning of a word part can vary by term.

Prefix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Common prefixes		
A-, An-	Without; lacking	Anemia
Andr/o-	Male	Androgen
Anti-	Against	Anticholinergic drugs
Auto-	Self	Autocrine
Bio-	Life	Biology
Chem/o-	Chemistry	Chemotherapy
Contra-	Against	Contraception
Cyt/o-	Cell	Cytokine
Dis-	Separation; taking apart	Dissection
Dys-	Difficult; abnormal	Dyspnea
Eu-	Good; well	Eupnea
Fibr/o-	Fiber	Fibrosis
Gluco-, Glyco-	Glucose; sugar	Glycogen
Gyn/o-, Gynec-	Female	Gynecology
Hydr/o-	Water	Hydrocephalus
Idio-	Self; one's own	Idiopathic
Lyso-, Lys-	Break down; destruction; dissolving	Lysosome
Mal-	Bad; abnormal	Malignant
Myc/o-	Fungus	Mycetoma
Necr/o-	Death	Necrosis
Neo-	New	Neonate
Oxy-	Sharp; acute; oxygen	Oxytocin
Pan-, Pant/o-	All or everywhere	Pancytopenia
Pharmaco-	Drug; medicine	Pharmacist
Re-	Again; backward	Rejuvenation
Somat/o-, Somatico-	Body; bodily	Somatic cell
Body-part prefixes		
Acous/o-	Hearing	Acoustic meatus
Aden/o-	Gland	Adenoid
Adip/o-	Fat	Adipocyte
Adren/o-	Gland	Adrenal cortex
Angi/o-	Blood vessel	Angioplasty
Arteri/o-	Artery	Arteriole
Arthr/o-	Joint	Arthroplasty
Bucc/o-	Cheek	Buccal cavity
Bronch/i-	Bronchus	Bronchioles
Burs/o-	Bursa	Bursa
Carcin/o-	Cancer	Basal cell carcinoma
Cardi/o-	Heart	Cardiology
Cephal/o-	Head	Cephalic flexure
Chol-	Bile	Cholesterol
Chondri-	Cartilage	Chondrosarcoma
Coron-	Heart	Coronary arteries
Cost-	Rib	Costal cartilage
Crani/o-	Brain	Cranium
Cutane-	Skin	Cutaneous
Cyst/o-, Cysti-	Bladder or sac	Cystoscopy
Derm-, Dermat/o-	Skin	Dermatologist
Duoden/o-	Duodenum	Duodenitis

Prefix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Gastr-	Stomach	Gastrectomy
Gloss-	Tongue	Glossectomy
Hem-, Hema-, Hemat-, Hemo-, Hemat/o-	Blood	Hematopoiesis
Hepat/o-, Hepatico-	Liver	Hepatic portal system
Hist/o-, Histio-	Tissue	Histology
Hyster/o-	Uterus	Hysterectomy
Ileo-	Ileum	Ileostomy
Ischi/o-	Ischium	Ischial tuberosity
Kerat/o-	Cornea (eye or skin)	Keratin
Lacrim/o-	Tear	Lacrimal fluid
Lact/o-, Lacti-	Milk	Lactose
Laryng/o-	Larynx	Laryngitis
Lingu/o-	Tongue	Lingual tonsil
Lip/o-	Fat	Lipolysis
Lymph/o-	Lymph	Lymphocyte
Mamm-, Mast/o-	Breast	Mammary glands
Mening/o-	Meninges	Meningitis
Muscul/o-	Muscle	Musculoskeletal
My/o-	Muscle	Myocardium
Myel/o-	Spinal cord or bone marrow	Myelin
Nephr/o-	Kidney	Nephron
Neur/i-, Neur/o-	Nerve	Neuron
Oculo-	Eye	Oculomotor nerve
Onco-	Tumor; bulk; volume	Oncogene
Onych/o-	Fingernail; toenail	Onychodystrophy
Oo-	Egg; ovary	Oocyte
Oophor/o-	Ovary	Oophorectomy
Op-, Opt-	Vision	Optic nerve
Ophthalm/o-	Eye	Ophthalmic artery
Orchid/o-, Orchio-	Testis	Orchidectomy
Orth/o-	Straight; normal; correct	Orthostatic
Osseo-	Bony	Osseous tissue
Ossi-	Bone	Ossicles
Ost-, Oste/o-	Bone	Osteoporosis
Ot/o-	Ear	Otolaryngologist
Ovar/i-, Ovario-, Ovi-, Ovo-	Ovary	Ovarian follicle
Phalang-	Phalanx	Phalanges
Pharyng/o-	Pharynx; throat	Pharyngeal tonsil
Phleb/o-	Vein	Phlebotomist
Phren/i-, Phreno-, Phrenico-	Diaphragm	Phrenic nerve
Pleur-, Pleur/a-, Pleur/o-	Rib; pleura	Pleural cavity
Pneum/a-, Pneumat/o-	Air; lung	Pneumonia
Proct/o-	Anus; rectum	Proctoscopy
Prostat-	Prostate	Prostatectomy
Pseudo-	False	Pseudostratified

Prefix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Psych/o-, Psyche-	Mind	Psychiatrist
Radio-	Radiation; radius	Radioisotopes
Ren/o-	Kidney	Renal cortex
Retin-	Retina	Retinitis pigmentosa
Rhin/o-	Nose	Rhinoscope
Salping/o-	Tube	Salpingo-oophorectomy
Sarco-	Muscular; flesh-like	Sarcomere
Schiz/o-	Split; cleft	Schizophrenia
Sclera-, Sclero-	Hardness	Sclerosis
Sigmoid/o-	Sigmoid colon	Sigmoidoscopy
Sperma-, Spermo-, Spermato-	Sperm	Spermatocyte
Splen/o-	Spleen	Splenomegaly
Sten/o-	Narrowed; blocked	Stenosis
Stern-	Sternum	Sternoclavicular joint
Stom/a-, Stomat/o-	Mouth	Stomatitis
Thorac/o-, Thoracico-	Chest	Thoracic cavity
Thromb/o-	Blood clot	Thrombolytic
Thyr/o-	Thyroid gland	Thyroiditis
Trache/o-	Trachea	Trachealis
Tympan/o-	Eardrum	Tympanic membrane
Ur/o-	Urine	Urologist
Vagin-	Vagina	Vaginal
Varic/o-	Duct; blood vessel	Varicose veins
Vasculo-	Blood vessel	Vasculitis
Ven/o-	Vein	Venae cavae
Vertbr-	Vertebra; spine	Vertebral column
Color prefixes		
Chlor/o-	Green	Chlorophyll
Chrom-, Chromato-	Color	Chromosome
Cyano-	Blue	Cyanosis
Erythr/o-	Red	Erythrocyte
Leuk/o-	White	Leukocyte
Melan/o-	Black	Melanin
Physical property and shape prefixes		
Cry/o-	Cold	Cryotherapy
Elect-	Electrical activity	Electrocardiogram
Kin/o-, Kine-, Kinesi/o-	Movement	Kinetic energy
Kyphy/o-	Humped	Kyphosis
Rhabd/o-	Rod-shaped; striated	Rhabdomyosarcoma
Phot/o-	Light	Photoreceptor
Reticul/o-	Net	Reticulocytes
Scoli/o-	Twisted	Scoliosis
Therm/o-	Heat	Thermotherapy
Direction and position prefixes		
Ab-, Abs-	Away from	Abductor
Ad-	Towards	Adductor
Ante-	Before; forward	Antenatal

Prefix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Circum-	Around	Circumcision
Cycl-	Circle; cycle	Cyclic neutropenia
De-	Away from; ending	Dehydration
Dia-	Across; through	Diagnosis
Ect/o-, Exo-	Outer; outside	Exocrine gland
End/o-, Ent-, Enter/o-	Within; inner	Endocrine gland
Epi-	Upon; outside of	Epidermis
Ex-, Extra-	Beyond	Expiration
Infra-	Beneath; below	Infratemporal fossa
Inter-	Between	Interstitial fluid
Intra-	Within	Intracellular fluid
Meso-	Middle	Mesoderm
Meta-	Beyond; change	Metabolism
Para-	Alongside; abnormal	Parathyroid glands
Path/o-	Disease	Pathologist
Peri-	Around	Pericardium
Post-	Behind; after	Postpartum
Pre-	Before; in front	Precancerous
Retro-	Backward; behind	Retroperitoneum
Sub-	Under	Subcutaneous layer
Super-	Above	Superior
Supra-	Above; upon	Supraglottis
Sy-, Syl-, Sym-, Syn-, Sys-	Together	Syndrome
Trans-	Across; through	Transdermal
Quantity prefixes		
Bi-	Two	Biceps
Brady-	Slow	Bradycardia
Diplo-	Double	Diploid
Hemi-	Half	Hemihypertrophy
Hetero-	Other; different	Heterogeneous
Homo-	Same	Homozygous genotype
Hyper-	Above; beyond; excessive	Hypertension
Hypo-	Under; deficient	Hypotension
Iso-	Equal; like	Isointense
Macro-	Large; long; big	Macrophage
Mic-, Micro-	Small	Microglia
Mon-, Mono-	One	Monocyte
Olig/o-	Few; little	Oliguria
Poly-	Many; excessive	Polyuria
Quadri-	Four	Quadriceps
Semi-	Half	Semilunar valves
Tachy-	Fast	Tachycardia
Tetra-	Four	Tetralogy of Fallot
Tri-	Three	Triceps
Uni-	One	Unicellular

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medicalterminology/chapter/prefixes-and-suffixes/

Medical Suffixes

Suffix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
-Stomy	A suffix meaning surgical creation of an opening,	colostomy or gastrostomy
-Tomy	A suffix meaning incision or cutting into	laparotomy or tracheotomy
Cidal	A suffix meaning killing or destroying,	bactericidal or fungicidal
Cide	A suffix meaning an agent or process that kills,	pesticide, bactericide, or homicide
Cyte	A suffix meaning cell,	erythrocyte or leukocyte
Cytosis	A suffix or term indicating a condition involving cells or, in some contexts, an increase in the number of a particular type of cell	leukocytosis or erythrocytosis
Dactyl-, -Dactyl	A combining form or suffix meaning finger or toe	polydactyly or brachydactyly
Ectomy	A suffix meaning surgical removal or excision,	appendectomy or mastectomy
Emia	A suffix meaning a condition of the blood or a substance present in the blood,	anemia or bacteremia
Iatrics	A suffix or word element referring to medical treatment or a medical specialty,	geriatrics and pediatrics
Iatry	A suffix meaning medical treatment or a medical specialty,	psychiatry and podiatry
Itis	A suffix meaning inflammation,	dermatitis, bronchitis, and arthritis
Kalemia	A suffix or term referring to the concentration of potassium in the blood,	hypokalemia or hyperkalemia
MAB	Abbreviation for monoclonal antibody; the suffix -mab in a generic drug name indicates a monoclonal antibody,	adalimumab or rituximab
Oma	-oma is a suffix commonly indicating a tumor or mass, although some words ending in -oma describe non-neoplastic conditions	lipoma or carcinoma
Pathy	A suffix meaning disease, disorder, or abnormality,	neuropathy, cardiomyopathy, and nephropathy
Plegia	-plegia is a suffix meaning paralysis,	paraplegia, hemiplegia, or quadriplegia

Complete reference tables

Suffix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
Common suffixes		
-ac	Pertaining to	Cardiac
-blast, -blasto, -blastic	Bud; germ	Myeloblast
-cyte, -cytic	Cell	Thrombocyte
-dynia	Pain; swelling	Thoracodynia
-eal, -ial	Pertaining to	Esophageal
-ectasis	Expansion; dilation	Atelectasis
-emia	Blood condition	Anemia
-ia	Condition	Hemophilia
-iasis	Condition; formation of	Psoriasis
-ism	Condition	Hypothyroidism
-ites, -itis	Inflammation	Arthritis
-ity	Pertaining to	Immunity
-ium	Structure or tissue	Epithelium
-lysis, -lytic	Breakdown; destruction; dissolving	Osteolytic
-malacia	Softening	Osteomalacia
-megaly	Enlargement	Acromegaly
-oid	Resembling	Arachnoid trabeculae
-oma	Tumor	Angiosarcoma
-osis	Condition; usually abnormal	Endometriosis
-ous	Pertaining to	Aqueous
-pathy	Disease	Lymphadenopathy
-penia	Deficiency; lack of	Thrombocytopenia
-phagia, -phagy	Eating; swallowing	Dysphagia
-phasia	Speech	Aphasia
-plasia, -plastic	Growth	Hyperplasia
-plegia	Paralysis	Hemiplegia
-pnea	Breathing	Sleep apnea
-poiesis	Production	Hemopoiesis
-ptosis	Falling; drooping	Apoptosis
-rrhage, -rrhagic	Bleeding	Hemorrhage
-rrhea	Flow or discharge	Diarrhea
-sclerosis	Hardening	Arteriosclerosis
-sis	Condition	Agranulocytosis
-stasis	Level; unchanging	Homeostasis
-trophy	Growth	Hypertrophy
-uria	In the urine	Anuria
Procedure suffixes		
-centesis	Surgical puncture to remove fluid	Thoracentesis
-desis	Surgical binding	Pleurodesis
-ectomy	Cut out; removal	Mastectomy
-gram	Record; picture	Electrocardiogram
-graph	Instrument used to create a record or picture	Electrocardiograph
-graphy	To record or take a picture	Echocardiography
-meter	Device used for measuring	Sphygmomanometer
-opsy	Visual examination	Biopsy

Suffix	Meaning	Example of use in medical terms
-ostomy	Opening	Colostomy
-otomy	Incision	Laparotomy
-pexy	Surgical fixation	Oophoropexy
-plasty	Surgical reconstruction	Vertebroplasty
-scope	For examining	Endoscope
-scopy	Examine	Endoscopy

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Alternate Names

Primary term	Alternate names
ACE	angiotensin-converting enzyme
ACE Inhibitor	angiotensin-converting enzyme inhibitor
Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome	AIDS
Adenosine Triphosphate	ATP
AIDS	acquired immunodeficiency syndrome
Alcoholism	alcohol dependence: A chronic
Alimentary Canal	gastrointestinal
AMD	age-related macular degeneration
Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme	ACE
Angiotensin-Converting Enzyme Inhibitor	ACE
Amyloid Precursor Protein	APP
ARB	angiotensin II receptor blockers
ATP	adenosine triphosphate
AV Node	atrioventricular node
Balloon Dilation	Balloon dilatation
BMD	bone mineral density
BMI	body-mass index
BPH	benign prostatic hyperplasia
CABG	coronary artery bypass graft
CBC	complete blood count
	mdash
CCU	coronary care unit
Cerebral Hemorrhage	hemorrhagic stroke
CFS	chronic fatigue syndrome
CK	creatine kinase
COX-2 Inhibitors	cyclooxygenase-2 inhibitors
CPAP	continuous positive airway pressure
CPR	cardiopulmonary resuscitation
CRP	C-reactive protein
DNA	deoxyribonucleic acid
DNR	do-not-resuscitate order
DRI	dietary reference intake
EBCT	electron-beam computed tomography
ECG	electrocardiogram
ED	erectile dysfunction

Primary term	Alternate names
EEG	electroencephalogram
EKG	electrocardiogram
EMG	electromyography
	mdash
FSH	follicle-stimulating hormone
GERD	gastroesophageal reflux disease
GFR	glomerular filtration rate
Gingiva	gums: a form of oral tissue that covers the roots of teeth and surrounding bone
GnRH	gonadotropin-releasing hormone
HbA1C	hemoglobin A1c
HDL	high-density lipoprotein
HEPA Filter	high-efficiency particulate air
HIV	human immunodeficiency virus
HLA	human leukocyte antigen
HPA	hypothalamic-pituitary-adrenal axis
Human Immunodeficiency Virus	HIV
IBD	inflammatory bowel disease
ICD	implantable cardioverter defibrillator
IgE	immunoglobulin E
IU	international unit
LDL	low-density lipoprotein
LH	luteinizing hormone
LVAD	left-ventricular assist device
MAOIs	monoamine oxidase inhibitors
METs	metabolic equivalents
MHC Molecule	major histocompatibility complex molecule
Mitral Valve Prolapse	Barlow's Syndrome; Barlow Syndrome (Mitral Valve Prolapse)
MRI	magnetic resonance imaging–a scan that creates detailed pictures of internal organs
MUSE	medicated urethral system for erection
NK	natural killer cells
NMDA Receptor	N-methyl-D-aspartame receptor
NO	nitric oxide
NSAID	nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug
PAD	peripheral artery disease
PCOS	polycystic ovary syndrome
PDE5 Inhibitors	phosphodiesterase type 5 inhibitors
PET Scan	positron emission tomography
PSA	prostate-specific antigen
PTCA	percutaneous transluminal coronary angioplasty
PTSD	post-traumatic stress disorder
RAST	radioallergosorbent test
RCT	randomized controlled trial
RDA	recommended dietary allowance
REM	rapid eye movement
RLS	restless legs syndrome
SAD	seasonal affective disorder
SERMs	selective estrogen receptor modulators
SSRIs	selective serotonin reuptake inhibitors

Primary term	Alternate names
Steroids	corticosteroids
	mdash
T Cell	T lymphocyte
TDD	telecommunications device for the deaf
	mdash
TENS	transcutaneous electrical nerve stimulation
	mdash
TIA	transient ischemic attack
tPA	tissue plasminogen activator
TSH	thyroid-stimulating hormone
VLDL	very-low-density lipoprotein
VSD	ventricular septal defect
	mdash
ABO Blood Group System	ABO Blood Group; ABO Blood Groups; ABO Blood Types; ABO System
Absolute Neutrophil Count	ANC
Aarskog-Scott syndrome	Aarskog Syndrome
Banti Syndrome	Banti disease; Banti's syndrome
Barber itch	Barber's itch
Glycated Hemoglobin (A1C)	A1C; A1C test; Hemoglobin A1C; HbA1C

British and US Medical Terms

This table lists common differences between United States and British medical terminology. Some terms are used in both countries, and local hospitals may use additional variations.

United States term	British term
Acetaminophen	Paracetamol
Anemia	Anaemia
Anesthesia	Anaesthesia
Anesthetic	Anaesthetic
Apnea	Apnoea
Behavior	Behaviour
Cesarean section	Caesarean section
Celiac disease	Coeliac disease
Color	Colour
Diarrhea	Diarrhoea
Edema	Oedema
Epinephrine	Adrenaline
Esophagus	Oesophagus
Fetal	Foetal
Fetus	Foetus
Gynecology	Gynaecology
Hemoglobin	Haemoglobin
Hemolysis	Haemolysis
Hemorrhage	Haemorrhage
Labor	Labour
Leukocyte	Leucocyte
Maneuver	Manoeuvre
Orthopedics	Orthopaedics
Pediatric	Paediatric
Pediatrician	Paediatrician
Practice (verb)	Practise (verb)
Sulfur	Sulphur
Tumor	Tumour

Common vocabulary differences

United States term	British term
Pap test or Pap smear	Cervical smear test

United States term	British term
Emergency department (ED)	Accident and emergency department (A&E)
Emergency room (ER)	Accident and emergency department (A&E)
Family physician	General practitioner (GP)
Operating room (OR)	Operating theatre
Primary care physician (PCP)	General practitioner (GP)
Skilled nursing facility	Nursing home
Urgent care center	Walk-in centre or minor injuries unit, depending on the service

Common Medical Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full form
ABG	Arterial blood gas
ACE	Angiotensin-converting enzyme
ACE inhibitor	Angiotensin-converting enzyme inhibitor
ACL	Anterior cruciate ligament
ACS	Acute coronary syndrome
ADHD	Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder
ADL	Activity of daily living
AED	Automated external defibrillator
AFib	Atrial fibrillation
AIDS	Acquired immunodeficiency syndrome
AKI	Acute kidney injury
ALP	Alkaline phosphatase
ALT	Alanine aminotransferase
AMI	Acute myocardial infarction
ALS	Amyotrophic lateral sclerosis; advanced life support, depending on context
ANC	Absolute neutrophil count
ANA	Antinuclear antibody
ANP	Atrial natriuretic peptide
APGAR	Appearance, pulse, grimace, activity, and respiration
ARDS	Acute respiratory distress syndrome
AST	Aspartate aminotransferase
ATN	Acute tubular necrosis
AV	Atrioventricular
AVM	Arteriovenous malformation
AVN	Atrioventricular node
BID	Twice a day; prescription shorthand that should be avoided when possible
BP	Blood pressure
BMI	Body mass index
BMR	Basal metabolic rate
BPH	Benign prostatic hyperplasia
BRCA	Breast cancer susceptibility gene; commonly referring to the BRCA1 or BRCA2 gene
BUN	Blood urea nitrogen
CABG	Coronary artery bypass graft
CA	Cancer antigen or calcium, depending on context
CA-125	Cancer antigen 125

Abbreviation	Full form
CAD	Coronary artery disease
CAT	Computed tomography; an older term for computerized axial tomography
CBC	Complete blood count
CBT	Cognitive behavioural therapy
CDC	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention
CEA	Carcinoembryonic antigen
CHF	Congestive heart failure
CHD	Congenital heart disease
CIN	Cervical intraepithelial neoplasia
CJD	Creutzfeldt–Jakob disease
CK	Creatine kinase
CMV	Cytomegalovirus
CNS	Central nervous system
COPD	Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease
CPAP	Continuous positive airway pressure
CPK	Creatine phosphokinase; an older name for creatine kinase
CPR	Cardiopulmonary resuscitation
CRF	Chronic renal failure; chronic kidney disease is preferred in current usage
CRP	C-reactive protein
CSF	Cerebrospinal fluid
CT	Computed tomography
CVS	Chorionic villus sampling
CVA	Cerebrovascular accident
CXR	Chest radiograph
D&C	Dilatation and curettage
DKA	Diabetic ketoacidosis
DJD	Degenerative joint disease
DM	Diabetes mellitus
DNA	Deoxyribonucleic acid
DTP	Diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis
DVT	Deep-vein thrombosis
DX	Diagnosis
ECG	Electrocardiogram
EKG	Electrocardiogram
ECHO	Echocardiogram
EEG	Electroencephalogram
eGFR	Estimated glomerular filtration rate
EMG	Electromyography
ENT	Ear, nose, and throat
ERCP	Endoscopic retrograde cholangiopancreatography
ESR	Erythrocyte sedimentation rate
ESRD	End-stage renal disease
FBC	Full blood count
FEV1	Forced expiratory volume in the first second
FSH	Follicle-stimulating hormone
GABHS	Group A beta-haemolytic streptococcus
GERD	Gastroesophageal reflux disease
GFR	Glomerular filtration rate
GI	Gastrointestinal
GIST	Gastrointestinal stromal tumour
GU	Genitourinary
HbA1c	Glycated haemoglobin

Abbreviation	Full form
HDL	High-density lipoprotein
HAV	Hepatitis A virus
HBV	Hepatitis B virus
HCT	Hematocrit
HCV	Hepatitis C virus
HGB	Hemoglobin
HIV	Human immunodeficiency virus
HLA	Human leukocyte antigen
HPV	Human papillomavirus
HRT	Hormone replacement therapy
HTN	Hypertension
IBD	Inflammatory bowel disease
IBS	Irritable bowel syndrome
ICD	Implantable cardioverter-defibrillator
ICU	Intensive care unit
IDDM	Insulin-dependent diabetes mellitus; type 1 diabetes mellitus is preferred in current usage
IM	Intramuscular
IU	International unit
IUD	Intrauterine device
IV	Intravenous
IVP	Intravenous pyelography or intravenous pyelogram
LDL	Low-density lipoprotein
LH	Luteinizing hormone
LFT	Liver function test
MI	Myocardial infarction
MMR	Measles, mumps, and rubella
MRI	Magnetic resonance imaging
MRSA	Methicillin-resistant *Staphylococcus aureus*
MS	Multiple sclerosis; may have other meanings depending on context
NG	Nasogastric
NIDDM	Non-insulin-dependent diabetes mellitus; type 2 diabetes mellitus is preferred in current usage
NKDA	No known drug allergies
NSAID	Nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug
OCD	Obsessive-compulsive disorder
PAD	Peripheral arterial disease
PAP	Papanicolaou
PCOS	Polycystic ovary syndrome
PCR	Polymerase chain reaction
PE	Pulmonary embolism
PET	Positron emission tomography
PFT	Pulmonary function test
PID	Pelvic inflammatory disease
PMS	Premenstrual syndrome
PPD	Purified protein derivative
PRN	As needed (from the Latin *pro re nata*)
PSA	Prostate-specific antigen
PT	Prothrombin time
PTCA	Percutaneous transluminal coronary angioplasty
PTH	Parathyroid hormone
PTT	Partial thromboplastin time

Abbreviation	Full form
PUD	Peptic ulcer disease
PVC	Premature ventricular contraction
QID	Four times a day; prescription shorthand that should be avoided when possible
RA	Rheumatoid arthritis; may have other meanings depending on context
RAST	Radioallergosorbent test
RBC	Red blood cell
RCT	Randomized controlled trial
REM	Rapid eye movement
RLS	Restless legs syndrome
RNA	Ribonucleic acid
RSV	Respiratory syncytial virus
Rx	Prescription or treatment, depending on context
SaO2	Arterial oxygen saturation
SARS-CoV-2	Severe acute respiratory syndrome coronavirus 2
SIDS	Sudden infant death syndrome
SLE	Systemic lupus erythematosus
SOB	Shortness of breath
SSRI	Selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor
STD	Sexually transmitted disease; sexually transmitted infection is preferred in current usage
STI	Sexually transmitted infection
T3	Triiodothyronine
T4	Thyroxine; commonly referring to tetraiodothyronine
TAH	Total abdominal hysterectomy
TB	Tuberculosis
TIA	Transient ischemic attack
TIBC	Total iron-binding capacity
TID	Three times a day; prescription shorthand that should be avoided when possible
TMJ	Temporomandibular joint
TORCH	Toxoplasmosis, other infections, rubella, cytomegalovirus, and herpes simplex; a group of congenital-infection evaluations
TSH	Thyroid-stimulating hormone
TURP	Transurethral resection of the prostate
URI	Upper respiratory infection
UTI	Urinary tract infection
VSD	Ventricular septal defect
WBC	White blood cell
WDWN	Well-developed, well-nourished
WNL	Within normal limits; a finding is within the expected reference range or clinical appearance
WHO	World Health Organization
XRT	Radiotherapy

A.C. A prescription abbreviation meaning "before meals," from the Latin *ante cibum*.

ALA An abbreviation for alpha-linolenic acid, an essential omega-3 fatty acid, or aminolevulinic acid, a heme-pathway compound used topically in some photodynamic treatments; context determines the meaning.

AP An abbreviation commonly meaning anteroposterior, or directed from front to back; in some contexts it may have another medical expansion.

ATM An abbreviation that may mean the temporomandibular joint or ataxia-telangiectasia mutated, a protein kinase involved in DNA-damage repair; context determines the meaning.

BF Physician's shorthand for Black female; demographic abbreviations should be used cautiously and replaced with precise, patient-preferred language when possible.

BPD An abbreviation commonly meaning bronchopulmonary dysplasia, chronic lung disease after premature birth; it can also mean borderline personality disorder in psychiatric contexts.

CA A medical abbreviation that may mean cancer, carcinoma, or calcium; the intended meaning depends on the surrounding clinical context.

CKD Abbreviation for Chronic Kidney Disease: a long-term condition in which the kidneys gradually lose their ability to filter waste products, excess minerals, and fluids from the blood.

CLA An abbreviation that commonly means conjugated linoleic acid, a group of fatty-acid isomers; in other medical contexts it may have a different expansion.

CTG Abbreviation for cardiotocography; continuous electronic monitoring of fetal heart rate and uterine contractions during labour.

CVA An abbreviation for cerebrovascular accident, meaning a stroke caused by interruption of blood flow to the brain or bleeding within the brain. It may cause sudden neurologic deficits.

CVS An abbreviation that may mean cardiovascular system or chorionic-villus sampling, a prenatal diagnostic procedure; context determines the meaning.

DDAVP The abbreviation for desmopressin, a synthetic vasopressin-like medicine used for some bleeding disorders, central diabetes insipidus, and nighttime urination.

DES An abbreviation that may mean diethylstilbestrol, a synthetic estrogen, or drug-eluting stent; diethylstilbestrol exposure during pregnancy is associated with later reproductive and cancer risks.

DHHS The abbreviation for the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services.

DNR An abbreviation for do-not-resuscitate, indicating that cardiopulmonary resuscitation should not be attempted if breathing or heartbeat stops.

DNS An abbreviation that may mean deviated nasal septum or dextrose in normal saline; the intended expansion depends on the clinical context.

DPT An older abbreviation for the combined diphtheria, pertussis, and tetanus vaccine; current formulations include DTaP and Tdap.

DT An abbreviation that may mean delirium tremens or diphtheria–tetanus vaccine; the intended meaning depends on context.

DTC An abbreviation that may mean differentiated thyroid carcinoma or direct-to-consumer, such as direct-to-consumer genetic testing; the intended meaning depends on context.

DTP An older abbreviation for diphtheria, tetanus, and pertussis vaccine; current childhood formulations are generally called DTaP.

DV An abbreviation that may mean domestic violence, ductus venosus, or another context-specific term; the full expression should be specified.

DYS An abbreviation or word root related to dysplasia, dystonia, dyslexia, or another condition beginning with dys-; the intended meaning depends on context.

EC An abbreviation that may mean enteric-coated, emergency contraception, or endothelial cell; the intended meaning depends on context.

EFT An abbreviation whose medical meaning depends on context, such as endocrine-function testing or emotional freedom technique; the intended expansion should be specified.

ENT Abbreviation for ear, nose, and throat; it commonly refers to the otolaryngology specialty or an otolaryngologist.

EOS Commonly an abbreviation for eosinophils or an eosinophil count in laboratory reports; the intended meaning should be confirmed from the report's context.

EPA Abbreviation for eicosapentaenoic acid, an omega-3 polyunsaturated fatty acid found in oily fish and fish-oil supplements.

EPR Abbreviation for electrophrenic respiration, also called diaphragm pacing, in which electrical stimulation helps activate the diaphragm in selected patients with respiratory muscle paralysis.

EPT Abbreviation for estrogen/progestin therapy, treatment using both an estrogen and a progestin, commonly discussed in menopausal hormone therapy when the uterus is present.

ER Abbreviation for emergency room or emergency department, the hospital service that evaluates and treats urgent illness and injury.

FCC In medicine, an abbreviation for familial colorectal cancer; in other contexts it may have nonmedical meanings.

FFI Abbreviation for fatal familial insomnia, a rare inherited prion disease causing progressively severe insomnia, autonomic dysfunction, and neurologic decline.

FISH Abbreviation for fluorescence in situ hybridization, a test that uses fluorescent DNA probes to detect specific genes, chromosomes, or chromosomal rearrangements in cells.

FLAP Abbreviation for 5-lipoxygenase-activating protein, a protein encoded by *ALOX5AP* that helps produce leukotrienes involved in inflammation.

GALT Abbreviation for gut-associated lymphoid tissue, immune tissue in the gastrointestinal tract that samples intestinal contents and helps defend against pathogens.

GBV-C Abbreviation for GB virus C, also called human pegivirus, a blood-borne virus that can persist in people but is not established as a cause of chronic hepatitis.

GD In the RxList medical-dictionary context, abbreviation for Gaucher disease, an inherited lysosomal storage disorder caused by deficient glucocerebrosidase.

GI Abbreviation for gastrointestinal, relating to the digestive tract from the mouth through the anus and its associated organs.

GPO Abbreviation for group purchasing organization, an organization that combines buyers' purchasing power to negotiate prices and contracts for medicines, supplies, or services.

HAART Abbreviation for highly active antiretroviral therapy, an older term for combination antiretroviral treatment used to suppress HIV replication and preserve immune function.

HAPE Abbreviation for high-altitude pulmonary edema, a life-threatening accumulation of fluid in the lungs after rapid ascent; immediate descent and supplemental oxygen are urgent treatments.

HAV Abbreviation for hepatitis A virus, an RNA virus spread mainly by the fecal–oral route that causes acute hepatitis but usually does not cause chronic infection.

HBV Abbreviation for hepatitis B virus, a DNA virus transmitted through infected blood or body fluids that can cause acute or chronic hepatitis and cirrhosis or liver cancer.

HEPA Abbreviation for high-efficiency particulate air, describing a filter designed to remove a very high proportion of airborne particles of specified sizes from an air stream.

HGD Commonly an abbreviation for high-grade dysplasia, a marked abnormality of cell development that may be a precursor to invasive cancer but is not itself invasive cancer.

HNP Abbreviation for herniated nucleus pulposus, in which the inner material of an intervertebral disk protrudes through the outer ring and may compress a nerve root.

HPS Common medical abbreviations include hantavirus pulmonary syndrome, a severe respiratory illness, and Hermansky–Pudlak syndrome, an inherited disorder with oculocutaneous albinism and platelet-storage abnormalities; context determines the meaning.

HS Commonly an abbreviation for hereditary spherocytosis, an inherited hemolytic anemia; it can also mean half-strength, heart sounds, hamstrings, heparan sulfate, hernia sac, or house surgeon, so context is essential.

HSA Abbreviation that may mean a US health savings account or human serum albumin, the main plasma protein that helps maintain oncotic pressure; context determines the meaning.

ICU Abbreviation for intensive care unit, a hospital unit providing continuous monitoring and specialized support for critically ill patients.

ID A context-dependent abbreviation that may mean infectious disease, infectious diseases specialist, intellectual disability, or identification; the surrounding clinical text determines the meaning.

IFA Abbreviation for indirect fluorescent antibody, a laboratory method that detects antibodies or antigens using fluorescent labels, commonly in serologic testing.

IHS Abbreviation for the Indian Health Service, a US federal agency providing health services to American Indians and Alaska Native people and communities.

IPT Abbreviation for interpersonal therapy, a structured psychotherapy that focuses on relationships, grief, role transitions, and interpersonal difficulties.

IPV Abbreviation for inactivated polio vaccine, an injectable vaccine containing killed poliovirus and used to prevent poliomyelitis.

IQ Abbreviation for intelligence quotient, a standardized score from cognitive testing; it describes performance on specified tests and is not a complete measure of a person's abilities or worth.

ITC Abbreviation for in-the-canal, describing a hearing aid or other device positioned within the ear canal.

ITN Abbreviation for insecticide-treated bednet, a net treated with insecticide to reduce mosquito bites and malaria transmission.

IVC Commonly abbreviation for inferior vena cava, the large vein returning blood from the lower body to the heart; it can also mean intravenous cholangiogram, an X-ray study of the biliary system.

JIP Abbreviation for juvenile intestinal polyposis, an inherited condition in which children develop multiple hamartomatous polyps in the gastrointestinal tract and may have increased cancer risk.

KB In medical usage, an abbreviation for keratoderma blennorrhagicum or kilobase of DNA; lower-case *kb* is preferred for kilobase, so context is important.

KUB Abbreviation for kidney, ureter, and bladder, commonly referring to a plain abdominal X-ray used to assess urinary tract calculi, bowel gas patterns, or other abdominal findings.

L Abbreviation for liter, a metric unit of volume equal to 1,000 milliliters.

LAVH Abbreviation for laparoscopically assisted vaginal hysterectomy, removal of the uterus through the vagina with laparoscopic assistance.

LL Commonly an abbreviation for lower lid of the eye or lower limit; the intended meaning depends on the clinical context.

LLL Abbreviation for the left lower lobe of the lung.

LLQ Abbreviation for left lower quadrant, usually referring to the lower-left quarter of the abdomen.

LMP Abbreviation for last menstrual period, the first day of the most recent menstrual bleeding, used in estimating gestational age when the date is reliable.

LPA LPA abbreviates Little People of America and may also refer to the left pulmonary artery.

LUL Abbreviation for the left upper lobe of the lung.

LUQ Abbreviation for the left upper quadrant of the abdomen.

LVF Abbreviation for left ventricular failure, meaning failure of the left side of the heart; it may also mean left ventricular function, depending on context.

MAOI Abbreviation for monoamine oxidase inhibitor, a drug that inhibits monoamine oxidase and is used in selected treatment of depression and other disorders.

MAP Common abbreviation for *Mycobacterium avium* subspecies *paratuberculosis*, an organism of the *M. avium* complex; the abbreviation can have other meanings in different clinical contexts.

MCD An abbreviation with several medical meanings, including minimal change disease, mean corpuscular diameter, and medullary cystic disease; the intended meaning depends on context.

MCP Membrane cofactor protein, also called CD46, is a cell-surface protein that regulates complement activation and helps protect host cells from complement-mediated injury; the abbreviation can have other meanings in different contexts.

MDI An abbreviation that may mean metered-dose inhaler, multiple daily injections, or mental developmental index; the intended meaning depends on context.

MEDVAC Abbreviation for medical evacuation: the transport of ill or injured people to a medical facility or to a location providing a higher level of care.

MI Abbreviation for myocardial infarction, or heart attack: death of heart-muscle tissue caused by prolonged inadequate blood flow, usually from acute coronary artery blockage.

MM An abbreviation that may mean meningomyelocele, malignant melanoma, or multiple myeloma; in lowercase, *mm* commonly means millimeter. The intended meaning depends on context.

MP Abbreviation for mercaptopurine, a purine-antimetabolite drug, or for molecular pathology; the intended meaning depends on context.

MPS Abbreviation for mucopolysaccharidosis, a group of inherited lysosomal storage disorders caused by deficient breakdown of glycosaminoglycans.

MSG Abbreviation for monosodium glutamate, the sodium salt of glutamic acid used as a flavor enhancer and contributing umami taste.

MTX Abbreviation for methotrexate, a folate-antagonist drug used in selected cancers, autoimmune diseases, and other conditions.

MVP Abbreviation for mitral valve prolapse, in which one or both mitral-valve leaflets bow into the left atrium during ventricular systole; it is often mild but can sometimes cause mitral regurgitation or arrhythmias.

MYH MYH is a gene-family abbreviation involving myosin or DNA-repair proteins; the specific gene and variant determine the clinical meaning.

ND ND is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean naturopathic doctor, neurodevelopmental, or another term; the full meaning should be specified.

NEP NEP is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean neuroendocrine pancreatic tumor, nasoendotracheal procedure, or another clinical term.

NF NF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including neurofibromatosis, a group of genetic disorders causing nerve-sheath tumors and other features.

NG NG commonly means nasogastric, referring to a tube passed through the nose into the stomach, but the abbreviation has other uses.

NS NS is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly normal saline, a sterile sodium-chloride solution, or not significant; the full term should be stated.

OB OB is an abbreviation commonly meaning obstetrics, the care of pregnancy, labor, birth, and the postpartum period, but it may have other meanings.

OBS OBS is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean observation, obstetric service, or organic brain syndrome; the intended term should be written out.

OCG OCG is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to oral contraceptive guidance, oculocardiac testing, or another clinical term; the full term should be specified.

OMS An abbreviation for oral and maxillofacial surgery; the intended meaning depends on the clinical context.

PAP PAP is an abbreviation with context-dependent meanings, including Papanicolaou testing, pulmonary alveolar proteinosis, or prostatic acid phosphatase; the full term should be specified.

PAS PAS is an abbreviation that may mean periodic-acid–Schiff staining, para-aminosalicylic acid, or pulmonary-artery systolic pressure; context determines the meaning.

PAT PAT is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to paroxysmal atrial tachycardia, a rapid rhythm beginning in the atria, or another clinical term.

PCA PCA is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly meaning patient-controlled analgesia, in which a patient activates prescribed doses from an infusion device.

PCT PCT is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean procalcitonin, porphyria cutanea tarda, or patient-care technician; the full term should be specified.

PDR PDR commonly means Physicians' Desk Reference, a drug-information reference, but the abbreviation has other uses and should be interpreted in context.

PEP PEP is a context-dependent abbreviation, including post-exposure prophylaxis, a preventive medicine course after a possible infection exposure.

PHS PHS is an abbreviation whose meaning depends on context, including public health service or primary hyperhidrosis; the full term should be specified.

PI PI is a context-dependent abbreviation, including principal investigator, pulmonary insufficiency, or protease inhibitor; the intended meaning must be specified.

PLP PLP commonly means pyridoxal 5′-phosphate, the active coenzyme form of vitamin B6 required by many enzymes, but the abbreviation has other uses.

PMD PMD is a context-dependent abbreviation, including Pelizaeus–Merzbacher disease, a rare inherited disorder of central myelination, or a professional medical designation.

PON PON is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to postoperative nausea, paraoxonase, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be stated.

PTU PTU is the abbreviation for propylthiouracil, an antithyroid medicine used selectively because of liver toxicity and other safety considerations.

PV PV is a context-dependent abbreviation, including polycythemia vera, plasma volume, or peripheral vision; the full term should be specified.

PVB PVB is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean paravertebral block, a regional anesthetic technique, or another medical term.

PX PX is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean prognosis, patient, prescription, or a genetic marker; clinical documentation should spell out the intended term.

Q.2H A prescription abbreviation meaning "every 2 hours." Medication instructions should use clear wording because abbreviation misinterpretation can cause dosing errors.

Q.3H. A prescription abbreviation meaning "every 3 hours." Medication instructions should use clear wording because abbreviation misinterpretation can cause dosing errors.

Q.S. A prescription abbreviation from the Latin "quantum sufficiat," meaning "quantity sufficient" to make the required amount or concentration. The exact quantity must be specified by the formulation or prescription context.

R/O R/O is an abbreviation for rule out, indicating that a condition is being considered but has not been confirmed; clear documentation should state the actual diagnostic question.

RAD Acronym whose medical meaning depends on context, commonly radiation absorbed dose or right axis deviation on an ECG.

RBC RBC is the abbreviation for red blood cell, the cell that transports oxygen with hemoglobin and carries carbon dioxide back toward the lungs.

RF RF is a context-dependent abbreviation, including rheumatoid factor, radiofrequency, or risk factor; the complete term should be stated.

RLL RLL is the abbreviation for right lower lobe, usually referring to the lower lobe of the right lung.

RLQ RLQ is the abbreviation for right lower quadrant of the abdomen, containing structures including the appendix, cecum, and right adnexa.

RML RML is the abbreviation for right middle lobe, the middle lobe of the right lung.

RP RP is a context-dependent abbreviation, commonly retinitis pigmentosa, an inherited retinal degeneration causing night blindness and progressive visual-field loss.

RUQ RUQ is the abbreviation for right upper quadrant of the abdomen, containing the liver, gallbladder, duodenum, and portions of bowel and kidney.

SGOT SGOT is the former abbreviation for AST, an enzyme measured in blood that can rise with injury to liver, heart, muscle, or other tissues.

SGPT SGPT is the former abbreviation for ALT, a liver-associated enzyme that rises in many forms of hepatocellular injury.

SHP SHP is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to a healthcare professional, a gene or protein, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be specified.

SLV SLV is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean single-lung ventilation, serum lithium value, or another term; the full meaning should be specified.

STD(S) Abbreviation for sexually transmitted disease(s), now often called sexually transmitted infections.

STS STS is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean soft-tissue sarcoma, sodium thiosulfate, or another clinical term; the full term should be stated.

TMR TMR is a context-dependent abbreviation, including targeted muscle reinnervation, a surgical technique used to improve control of a prosthesis and reduce amputation pain.

TPA/TPA Abbreviation for tissue plasminogen activator.

TSD TSD is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean total sleep deprivation, traumatic stress disorder, or another clinical term; the full term should be specified.

TSE TSE is a context-dependent abbreviation, including transmissible spongiform encephalopathy, the prion-disease group that includes Creutzfeldt-Jakob disease.

UL UL is a context-dependent abbreviation that may mean upper limit, ulnar or ulna-related, or another clinical term; the full meaning should be specified.

URG URG is a context-dependent abbreviation that may refer to urinary urgency or an urgent clinical priority; documentation should state the full term.

URTI Abbreviation for upper respiratory tract infection, commonly involving the nose, sinuses, pharynx, or larynx and often caused by viruses.

VD Abbreviation for venereal disease, an older term for a sexually transmitted infection.

WBS Abbreviation for Williams–Beuren syndrome, a genetic condition associated with characteristic facial features, developmental differences, and cardiovascular disease. In other clinical contexts, WBS may have a different meaning, so the full term should be specified.

Modern Terms

Old or obsolete term	Modern or preferred term
Acute renal failure	Acute kidney injury
Adult-onset diabetes mellitus	Type 2 diabetes mellitus
Ague	Malaria; a historical term for intermittent fever, usually associated with malaria
Apoplexy	Stroke or intracerebral haemorrhage, depending on the historical context
Arteriosclerosis obliterans	Peripheral arterial disease
Bright's disease	Glomerular kidney disease; the specific modern diagnosis should be stated when known
Chronic renal failure	Chronic kidney disease
Congestive heart failure	Heart failure
Consumption	Tuberculosis, especially pulmonary tuberculosis
Crippling arthritis	Disabling arthritis; describe the functional limitation specifically
Diabetic retinopathy, background	Mild or nonproliferative diabetic retinopathy, with severity stated
Dropsy	Oedema or fluid accumulation, with the affected site specified
Eclampsia toxemia	Preeclampsia or eclampsia, depending on the clinical condition
Essential hypertension	Primary hypertension
Fallopian tube	Uterine tube; fallopian tube remains an accepted anatomical term
Female hysteria	No single modern diagnosis; reassess using the presenting symptoms and an appropriate diagnosis
Gastric ulcer disease	Peptic ulcer disease, with the ulcer site specified
Heart attack	Myocardial infarction in formal medical usage
Herpes zoster	Shingles in common language; herpes zoster remains the preferred medical term
Hyperlipaemia	Hyperlipidaemia
Idiopathic thrombocytopenic purpura	Immune thrombocytopenia
Imbecile	Intellectual disability; the historical term is offensive and must not be used clinically
Insulin-dependent diabetes mellitus	Type 1 diabetes mellitus
Junkie's abscess	Injection-related abscess or skin and soft-tissue infection
Leprosy	Hansen disease; leprosy remains a recognized medical term, but person-first language is preferred

Old or obsolete term	Modern or preferred term
Manic depression	Bipolar disorder
Mongolism	Down syndrome; the historical term is unacceptable and must not be used
Multiple personality disorder	Dissociative identity disorder
Non-insulin-dependent diabetes mellitus	Type 2 diabetes mellitus
Old age dementia	Dementia or major neurocognitive disorder, with the cause specified when known
Palsy	Paralysis or the specific neurological disorder, depending on the context
Paralytic stroke	Stroke with paralysis; specify the neurological deficit and stroke type
Phthisis	Pulmonary tuberculosis; historically, progressive wasting disease
Senile dementia	Dementia or major neurocognitive disorder; age alone should not define the diagnosis
Senility	Cognitive impairment, dementia, or another specific diagnosis, after assessment
Spastic colon	Irritable bowel syndrome
Stomach flu	Acute gastroenteritis
Sunstroke	Heatstroke
Terminal illness	Advanced or life-limiting illness, with the diagnosis and prognosis specified
Toxemia of pregnancy	Preeclampsia or eclampsia
Venereal disease	Sexually transmitted infection
Wassermann reaction	A modern syphilis serologic test, such as a nontreponemal or treponemal test
Water on the brain	Hydrocephalus

Medical Specialties

Medical specialty	Principal area of practice
Allergy and Immunology	Allergic disease, asthma, immune deficiency, and immune-mediated disorders
Anesthesiology	Perioperative care, anesthesia, critical care, and pain medicine
Cardiology	Diseases of the heart and circulatory system
Cardiothoracic Surgery	Surgical treatment of diseases of the heart, lungs, and chest
Clinical Genetics	Diagnosis, counseling, and management of inherited and genomic disorders
Clinical Pharmacology	Effects, uses, interactions, and safe clinical use of medicines
Colon and Rectal Surgery	Surgical treatment of diseases of the colon, rectum, and anus
Critical Care Medicine	Assessment and treatment of life-threatening organ dysfunction
Dermatology	Diseases of the skin, hair, nails, and mucous membranes
Emergency Medicine	Immediate assessment and treatment of acute illness and injury
Endocrinology	Hormones, metabolism, diabetes, and endocrine glands
Family Medicine	Comprehensive continuing care for individuals and families of all ages
Forensic Medicine	Application of medical knowledge to legal and medicolegal questions
Gastroenterology	Diseases of the digestive tract, liver, gallbladder, and pancreas
General Practice	First-contact and continuing medical care across a broad range of conditions
General Surgery	Operative treatment of diseases involving multiple body systems
Geriatric Medicine	Health care of older adults, including multimorbidity and functional decline
Hematology	Blood cells, blood-forming organs, clotting, and blood disorders
Hepatology	Diseases of the liver and biliary system
Hospital Medicine	Comprehensive medical care of hospitalized adults
Infectious Disease Medicine	Diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of infections
Internal Medicine	Prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of adult medical disorders
Interventional Cardiology	Catheter-based diagnosis and treatment of cardiovascular disease
Interventional Radiology	Image-guided minimally invasive diagnosis and treatment
Medical Oncology	Systemic treatment and supportive care for cancer
Neonatology	Care of newborn infants, especially premature or critically ill infants
Nephrology	Diseases of the kidneys, fluid balance, electrolytes, and hypertension
Neurology	Diseases of the brain, spinal cord, peripheral nerves, and muscles

Medical specialty	Principal area of practice
Neurosurgery	Surgical treatment of disorders of the nervous system
Nuclear Medicine	Diagnosis and treatment using radioactive substances and molecular imaging
Obstetrics and Gynecology	Pregnancy, childbirth, and diseases of the female reproductive system
Occupational Medicine	Health, safety, and disease prevention in the workplace
Ophthalmology	Medical and surgical care of the eyes and visual system
Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery	Surgical treatment of diseases and injuries of the mouth, jaws, face, and neck
Orthopedic Surgery	Surgical and nonsurgical treatment of the musculoskeletal system
Otolaryngology–Head and Neck Surgery	Diseases and surgery of the ear, nose, throat, and head and neck
Pain Medicine	Assessment and treatment of acute, chronic, and cancer-related pain
Palliative Medicine	Relief of symptoms and support for people with serious or life-limiting illness
Pathology	Laboratory examination of tissues, cells, blood, and body fluids
Pediatric Surgery	Surgical care of infants, children, and adolescents
Pediatrics	Medical care of infants, children, and adolescents
Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation	Restoration of function and independence after illness or injury
Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery	Reconstruction, restoration, and alteration of body tissues
Preventive Medicine	Prevention of disease and promotion of health in individuals and populations
Psychiatry	Diagnosis and treatment of mental, emotional, and behavioral disorders
Public Health Medicine	Protection and improvement of population health
Pulmonary Medicine	Diseases of the lungs and respiratory system
Radiation Oncology	Use of ionizing radiation to treat cancer
Radiology	Diagnostic and image-guided evaluation of disease
Reproductive Endocrinology and Infertility	Hormonal and reproductive disorders and fertility care
Rheumatology	Autoimmune, inflammatory, and musculoskeletal disorders
Sleep Medicine	Sleep disorders and their effects on health
Sports Medicine	Prevention, diagnosis, treatment, and rehabilitation of activity-related conditions
Thoracic Surgery	Surgery of the chest, lungs, esophagus, and mediastinum
Transfusion Medicine	Collection, testing, processing, and clinical use of blood components
Trauma Surgery	Surgical management of serious and complex injuries
Urology	Diseases of the urinary tract and male reproductive system
Vascular Surgery	Surgical and endovascular treatment of blood-vessel disease

Human Organs

This reference maps individual organ headwords to related entries in the dictionary. Each headword is followed by a semicolon-separated list of related dictionary terms.

Adrenal Gland
Adrenal Gland; Addison's Disease; Cushing's Syndrome; Pheochromocytoma; Adrenaline.

Appendix
Appendix; Appendicitis; Appendectomy.

Bladder
Bladder; Cystitis; Urinary Retention; Bladder Cancer.

Brain
Brain; Brain Tumour; Stroke; Seizure; Meningitis; Cerebral Palsy; Parkinson's Disease.

Breast
Breast; Breast Cancer; Mastitis; Mammography.

Cervix
Cervix; Cervical Cancer; Cervicitis; Pap Smear.

Colon
Colon; Colitis; Constipation; Diarrhea; Colorectal Cancer; Colonoscopy.

Ear
Ear; Otitis Media; Tinnitus; Hearing Loss; Vertigo.

Esophagus
Esophagus; Dysphagia; Esophagitis; Achalasia; Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease.

Eye
Eye; Cataract; Glaucoma; Conjunctivitis; Retinal Detachment; Macular Degeneration.

Gallbladder
Gallbladder; Cholelithiasis; Cholecystitis; Bile Duct; Cholangiocarcinoma.

Heart
Heart; Heart Failure; Arrhythmia; Myocardial Infarction; Pericarditis; Congenital Heart Defect.

Kidney
Kidney; Acute Kidney Injury; Chronic Kidney Disease; Glomerulonephritis; Nephritis; Dialysis.

Liver
Liver; Hepatitis; Cirrhosis; Fatty Liver Disease; Jaundice; Portal Hypertension.

Lung
Lung; Asthma; COPD; Pneumonia; Bronchitis; Pulmonary Embolism; Pleural Effusion.

Mouth
Mouth; Dental Caries; Gingivitis; Periodontitis.

Nose
Nose; Sinusitis; Rhinitis; Nasal Polyps; Anosmia; Epistaxis.

Ovary
Ovary; Ovarian Cyst; Ovarian Cancer; Fallopian Tube; Ectopic Pregnancy.

Pancreas
Pancreas; Pancreatitis; Diabetes Mellitus; Pancreatic Cancer; Insulin.

Pituitary Gland
Pituitary Gland; Pituitary Tumor; Acromegaly; Diabetes Insipidus.

Prostate
Prostate; Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia; Prostatitis; Prostate Cancer.

Rectum
Rectum; Rectal Bleeding; Proctitis; Rectal Cancer.

Skin
Skin; Dermatitis; Eczema; Psoriasis; Cellulitis; Pressure Ulcer; Melanoma.

Small Intestine
Small Intestine; Enteritis; Celiac Disease; Malabsorption; Intestinal Obstruction.

Spinal Cord
Spinal Cord; Spinal Cord Injury; Myelitis; Spinal Stenosis; Paraplegia.

Spleen
Spleen; Splenomegaly; Splenectomy; Hypersplenism.

Stomach
Stomach; Gastritis; Peptic Ulcer Disease; Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease; Gastric Cancer.

Testis
Testis; Testicular Torsion; Testicular Cancer; Epididymis.

Thymus
Thymus; Thymoma.

Thyroid Gland
Thyroid Gland; Hyperthyroidism; Hypothyroidism; Goitre; Thyroid Cancer.

Ureter
Ureter; Ureteral Calculi; Ureteral Obstruction; Ureteritis; Ureteral Stricture.

Urethra
Urethra; Urethral Stricture; Urethritis; Urethral Obstruction.

Uterus
Uterus; Endometriosis; Fibroids; Uterine Cancer; Ectopic Pregnancy.

Vagina
Vagina; Vaginitis; Vaginal Discharge; Vaginal Cancer.

Common Diseases

Scope: This reference-oriented list organizes common human diseases by organ system and clinical domain. It is a curated, high-importance list rather than a prevalence ranking, and some diseases appear under more than one heading where they are clinically relevant to several systems. It is not an exhaustive index of every term in the dictionary. Entries named as syndromes are covered in the companion appendix, Common Syndromes; conditions conventionally classified as disorders are covered in Common Disorders; and clinical findings, lesions, congenital anomalies, and injuries are covered in their own companion appendices. Individual symptoms, signs, and laboratory findings are defined as dictionary entries rather than listed here.

Cardiovascular Diseases Hypertension; Coronary Artery Disease; Stable Angina; Unstable Angina; Myocardial Infarction; Atherosclerosis; Heart Failure; Right Heart Failure; Cardiogenic Shock; Atrial Fibrillation; Atrial Flutter; Supraventricular Tachycardia; Ventricular Tachycardia; Ventricular Fibrillation; Sinus Bradycardia; Heart Block; Cardiomyopathy; Dilated Cardiomyopathy; Hypertrophic Cardiomyopathy; Restrictive Cardiomyopathy; Myocarditis; Pericarditis; Cardiac Tamponade; Endocarditis; Rheumatic Heart Disease; Aortic Stenosis; Aortic Regurgitation; Mitral Stenosis; Mitral Regurgitation; Mitral Valve Prolapse; Tricuspid Valve Disease; Pulmonary Hypertension; Peripheral Artery Disease; Aortic Aneurysm; Aortic Dissection; Deep Vein Thrombosis; Chronic Venous Insufficiency; Varicose Veins; Thrombophlebitis; Raynaud Phenomenon; Congenital Heart Disease.

Respiratory Diseases Asthma; Acute Bronchitis; Chronic Bronchitis; Emphysema; COPD; Pneumonia; Aspiration Pneumonia; Bronchopneumonia; Tuberculosis; COVID-19; Influenza; Bronchiolitis; Bronchiectasis; Cystic Fibrosis; Interstitial Lung Disease; Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis; Pneumoconiosis; Silicosis; Asbestosis; Hypersensitivity Pneumonitis; Sarcoidosis; Pulmonary Edema; Pulmonary Embolism; Pulmonary Hypertension; Respiratory Failure; Pleurisy; Empyema; Lung Abscess; Occupational Lung Disease.

Gastrointestinal Diseases Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease; Esophagitis; Barrett Esophagus; Achalasia; Esophageal Spasm; Gastritis; Peptic Ulcer Disease; Gastric Ulcer; Duodenal Ulcer; Gastroenteritis; Diarrheal Disease; Gastroparesis; Crohn Disease; Ulcerative Colitis; Inflammatory Bowel Disease; Celiac Disease; Lactose Intolerance; Food Intolerance; Intestinal Obstruction; Ileus; Intussusception; Volvulus; Diverticulosis; Diverticulitis; Appendicitis; Peritonitis; Hemorrhoids; Anal Fissure; Anal Fistula; Rectal Prolapse; Mesenteric Ischemia.

Liver, Gallbladder & Biliary Diseases Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease (MASLD); Alcoholic Liver Disease; Hepatitis A; Hepatitis B; Hepatitis C; Hepatitis D; Hepatitis E; Autoimmune Hepatitis; Acute Liver Failure; Chronic Liver Disease; Cirrhosis; Portal Hypertension; Hepatic Encephalopathy; Hemochromatosis; Wilson Disease; Primary Biliary Cholangitis; Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis; Cholelithiasis; Cholecystitis; Cholangitis.

Pancreatic Diseases Acute Pancreatitis; Chronic Pancreatitis; Autoimmune Pancreatitis; Pancreatic Insufficiency; Pancreatic Cancer; Pancreatic Neuroendocrine Tumors.

Kidney & Urinary Diseases Acute Kidney Injury; Chronic Kidney Disease; End-Stage Kidney Disease; Glomerulonephritis; Diabetic Nephropathy; Hypertensive Nephropathy; Interstitial Nephritis; Pyelonephritis; Urinary

Tract Infection; Cystitis; Urethritis; Nephrolithiasis; Hydronephrosis; Polycystic Kidney Disease; Renal Tubular Acidosis; IgA Nephropathy; Minimal Change Disease; Focal Segmental Glomerulosclerosis; Membranous Nephropathy; Vesicoureteral Reflux.

Endocrine Diseases Type 1 Diabetes Mellitus; Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus; Gestational Diabetes; Diabetes Insipidus; Diabetic Ketoacidosis; Hyperosmolar Hyperglycemic State; Hypothyroidism; Hyperthyroidism; Hashimoto Thyroiditis; Graves Disease; Thyroiditis; Goiter; Addison Disease; Cushing Disease; Primary Aldosteronism; Hypoparathyroidism; Hyperparathyroidism; Pheochromocytoma; Pituitary Adenoma; Acromegaly; Gigantism; Growth Hormone Deficiency.

Metabolic Diseases Obesity; Gout; Dyslipidemia; Hypercholesterolemia; Hypertriglyceridemia; Porphyria; Amyloidosis.

Nutritional Diseases & Deficiencies Protein-Energy Malnutrition; Marasmus; Kwashiorkor; Iron Deficiency; Iron-Deficiency Anemia; Vitamin A Deficiency; Thiamine Deficiency; Beriberi; Riboflavin Deficiency; Niacin Deficiency; Pellagra; Folate Deficiency; Vitamin B12 Deficiency; Vitamin C Deficiency; Scurvy; Vitamin D Deficiency; Rickets; Osteomalacia; Vitamin K Deficiency; Iodine Deficiency; Zinc Deficiency; Copper Deficiency; Selenium Deficiency; Magnesium Deficiency.

Neurological Diseases Tension-Type Headache; Cluster Headache; Status Epilepticus; Stroke; Ischemic Stroke; Hemorrhagic Stroke; Transient Ischemic Attack; Cerebral Aneurysm; Parkinson Disease; Alzheimer Disease; Vascular Dementia; Frontotemporal Dementia; Lewy Body Dementia; Multiple Sclerosis; Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis; Huntington Disease; Diabetic Neuropathy; Myasthenia Gravis; Bell Palsy; Trigeminal Neuralgia; Radiculopathy; Meningitis; Encephalitis; Hydrocephalus; Cerebral Palsy.

Musculoskeletal Diseases Osteoarthritis; Osteoporosis; Osteomalacia; Rheumatoid Arthritis; Ankylosing Spondylitis; Psoriatic Arthritis; Reactive Arthritis; Septic Arthritis; Gout; Bursitis; Tendinitis; Tendinopathy; Frozen Shoulder; Tennis Elbow; Golfer's Elbow; Cervical Spondylosis; Lumbar Spondylosis; Spinal Stenosis; Herniated Disc; Scoliosis; Kyphosis; Spondylolisthesis; Fibromyalgia; Muscular Dystrophy; Myositis; Polymyositis; Dermatomyositis.

Rheumatologic & Autoimmune Diseases Rheumatoid Arthritis; Systemic Lupus Erythematosus; Polymyalgia Rheumatica; Giant Cell Arteritis; Polyarteritis Nodosa; Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis; Microscopic Polyangiitis; Behçet Disease; Inflammatory Myopathies; Ankylosing Spondylitis; Psoriatic Arthritis; Reactive Arthritis; Relapsing Polychondritis; Adult-Onset Still Disease.

Skin, Hair & Nail Diseases Acne Vulgaris; Rosacea; Atopic Dermatitis; Contact Dermatitis; Seborrheic Dermatitis; Psoriasis; Urticaria; Angioedema; Impetigo; Cellulitis; Erysipelas; Folliculitis; Boils; Carbuncle; Ringworm; Athlete's Foot; Jock Itch; Candidiasis; Scabies; Pediculosis; Wart; Molluscum Contagiosum; Herpes Simplex; Herpes Zoster; Hidradenitis Suppurativa; Pressure Ulcers; Onychomycosis.

Eye Diseases Amblyopia; Strabismus; Cataract; Open-Angle Glaucoma; Angle-Closure Glaucoma; Conjunctivitis; Keratitis; Corneal Ulcer; Dry Eye; Uveitis; Iritis; Retinal Detachment; Diabetic Retinopathy; Hypertensive Retinopathy; Macular Degeneration; Retinitis Pigmentosa; Central Retinal Artery Occlusion; Central Retinal Vein Occlusion; Optic Neuritis; Keratoconus; Blepharitis.

Ear & Hearing Diseases Otitis Externa; Acute Otitis Media; Chronic Otitis Media; Otitis Media with Effusion; Mastoiditis; Presbycusis; Meniere Disease; Labyrinthitis; Vestibular Neuritis; Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo; Otosclerosis; Cholesteatoma; Acoustic Neuroma.

Nose, Sinus & Throat Diseases Allergic Rhinitis; Nonallergic Rhinitis; Acute Sinusitis; Chronic Sinusitis; Pharyngitis; Streptococcal Pharyngitis; Tonsillitis; Peritonsillar Abscess; Laryngitis; Epiglottitis; Vocal Cord Paralysis.

Oral & Dental Diseases Dental Caries; Pulpitis; Dental Abscess; Gingivitis; Periodontitis; Pericoronitis; Aphthous Ulcer; Oral Candidiasis; Leukoplakia; Oral Lichen Planus.

Blood Diseases Iron-Deficiency Anemia; Megaloblastic Anemia; Vitamin B12 Deficiency Anemia; Folate-Deficiency Anemia; Aplastic Anemia; Hemolytic Anemia; Sickle Cell Disease; Thalassemia; Hereditary Spherocytosis; Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase Deficiency; Polycythemia Vera; Immune Thrombocytopenia; Agranulocytosis; Hemophilia A; Hemophilia B; Von Willebrand Disease; Disseminated Intravascular Coagulation (DIC); Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (TTP).

Immune-System Diseases Primary Immunodeficiency; Severe Combined Immunodeficiency; Common Variable Immunodeficiency; Selective IgA Deficiency; AIDS (Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome); HIV/AIDS; Chronic Granulomatous Disease; Graft-Versus-Host Disease.

Infectious & Parasitic Diseases Common Cold; Influenza; COVID-19; Measles; Mumps; Rubella; Chickenpox; Shingles; Herpes Simplex; Infectious Mononucleosis; Cytomegalovirus Infection; Polio; Rabies; Dengue; Chikungunya; Zika; Hepatitis A; Hepatitis B; Hepatitis C; Hepatitis D; Hepatitis E; HIV; Syphilis; Gonorrhea; Chlamydia; Tuberculosis; Leprosy; Diphtheria; Pertussis; Tetanus; Typhoid Fever; Cholera; Plague; Bacterial Meningitis; Meningococcemia; Scarlet Fever; Salmonellosis; Shigellosis; Campylobacteriosis; Botulism; Brucellosis; Leptospirosis; Lyme Disease; Malaria; Amebiasis; Giardiasis; Toxoplasmosis; Leishmaniasis; Trichomoniasis; Ascariasis; Hookworm; Pinworm Infection; Schistosomiasis; Taeniasis; Echinococcosis; Candidiasis; Aspergillosis; Cryptococcosis; Histoplasmosis.

Female Reproductive & Gynecological Diseases Endometriosis; Adenomyosis; Uterine Fibroids; Ovarian Torsion; Pelvic Inflammatory Disease; Vaginitis; Bacterial Vaginosis; Vulvovaginal Candidiasis; Vulvodynia; Pelvic Organ Prolapse; Female Infertility; Premature Ovarian Insufficiency.

Male Reproductive & Urological Diseases Male Infertility; Benign Prostatic Hyperplasia; Prostatitis; Epididymitis; Orchitis; Testicular Torsion; Cryptorchidism; Phimosis; Paraphimosis; Peyronie Disease; Balanitis; Hypogonadism.

Pregnancy & Postpartum Diseases Hyperemesis Gravidarum; Gestational Diabetes; Gestational Hypertension; Preeclampsia; Eclampsia; Puerperal Infection; Postpartum Endometritis; Postpartum Depression; Mastitis.

Pediatric & Neonatal Diseases Respiratory Distress Syndrome; Neonatal Sepsis; Birth Asphyxia; Necrotizing Enterocolitis; Diaper Rash; Croup; Bronchiolitis; Cerebral Palsy; Congenital Hypothyroidism; Kawasaki Disease; Rheumatic Fever; Hand-Foot-and-Mouth Disease.

Genetic & Chromosomal Diseases Cystic Fibrosis; Sickle Cell Disease; Thalassemia; Huntington Disease; Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy; Becker Muscular Dystrophy; Neurofibromatosis; Tuberous Sclerosis; Tay-Sachs Disease; Gaucher Disease; Achondroplasia; Hemochromatosis; Wilson Disease.

Cancers & Other Neoplasms Breast Cancer; Lung Cancer; Colorectal Cancer; Prostate Cancer; Cervical Cancer; Ovarian Cancer; Endometrial Cancer; Vulvar Cancer; Vaginal Cancer; Testicular Cancer; Penile Cancer; Bladder Cancer; Kidney Cancer; Thyroid Cancer; Oral Cancer; Oropharyngeal Cancer; Laryngeal Cancer; Esophageal Cancer; Stomach Cancer; Liver Cancer; Gallbladder Cancer; Pancreatic Cancer; Small-Intestinal Cancer; Anal Cancer; Melanoma; Basal-Cell Carcinoma; Squamous-Cell Carcinoma; Osteosarcoma; Ewing Sarcoma; Soft-Tissue Sarcoma; Glioma; Glioblastoma; Meningioma; Leukemia; Hodgkin Lymphoma; Non-Hodgkin Lymphoma; Multiple Myeloma; Neuroblastoma; Retinoblastoma.

Multisystem & Systemic Diseases Fibromyalgia; Sarcoidosis; Amyloidosis; Sepsis; Septic Shock.

Common Disorders

Scope: This reference-oriented list organizes human conditions conventionally classified as clinical disorders by medical specialty and organ system. In medical nomenclature, disorders represent disruptions to regular bodily structure or function (frequently functional, metabolic, neurobehavioral, or regulatory disturbances), complementing the disease classifications in Common Diseases and clinical signs in Common Syndromes. Every entity listed corresponds to a defined medical concept in the dictionary.

Mental & Behavioral Disorders Generalized Anxiety Disorder; Panic Disorder; Social Anxiety Disorder; Agoraphobia; Specific Phobia; Major Depressive Disorder; Persistent Depressive Disorder; Bipolar Disorder; Cyclothymic Disorder; Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder; Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder; Acute Stress Disorder; Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder; Autism Spectrum Disorder; Schizophrenia; Schizoaffective Disorder; Delusional Disorder; Brief Psychotic Disorder; Eating Disorders; Alcohol Use Disorder; Opioid Use Disorder; Substance Abuse; Dissociative Identity Disorder; Depersonalization.

Personality Disorders Borderline Personality Disorder; Antisocial Personality Disorder; Narcissistic Personality Disorder; Avoidant Personality Disorder; Dependent Personality Disorder; Obsessive-Compulsive Personality Disorder; Paranoid Personality Disorder; Schizoid Personality Disorder; Schizotypal Personality Disorder; Histrionic Personality Disorder.

Eating & Nutrition Disorders Anorexia Nervosa; Bulimia Nervosa; Binge-Eating Disorder; Avoidant/Restrictive Food Intake Disorder; Pica; Rumination.

Impulse-Control & Conduct Disorders Intermittent Explosive Disorder; Kleptomania; Pyromania; Oppositional Defiant Disorder; Conduct Disorder; Trichotillomania; Excoriation Disorder.

Somatic & Related Disorders Somatic Symptom Disorder; Illness Anxiety Disorder; Conversion Disorder; Factitious Disorder.

Sleep-Wake Disorders Insomnia; Hypersomnia; Narcolepsy; Obstructive Sleep Apnea; Central Sleep Apnea; Sleepwalking; Night Terrors; Nightmare Disorder; REM Sleep Behavior Disorder; Restless Legs Syndrome; Delayed Sleep Phase.

Neurological & Movement Disorders Migraine; Cluster Headache; Tension-Type Headache; Epilepsy; Seizure Disorder; Essential Tremor; Parkinson's Disease; Dystonia; Chorea; Myoclonus; Tic Disorder; Tourette Disorder; Ataxia; Stiff-Person Syndrome.

Neurodevelopmental & Learning Disorders Intellectual Disability; Language Disorder; Stuttering; Specific Learning Disorder; Dyslexia; Developmental Coordination Disorder; Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder.

Autonomic Disorders Dysautonomia; Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome; Orthostatic Hypotension; Neurocardiogenic Syncope; Multiple System Atrophy; Autonomic Neuropathy.

Cardiovascular & Hemodynamic Disorders Heart Arrhythmia; Atrioventricular Block; Bundle Branch Block; Microvascular Angina; Cardiac Syndrome X; Orthostatic Intolerance.

Respiratory & Ventilatory Disorders Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disorder; Hypoventilation; Obesity Hypoventilation Syndrome; Pulmonary Fibrosis; Upper Airway Resistance Syndrome; Hyperventilation.

Digestive & Functional GI Disorders Irritable Bowel Syndrome; Functional Dyspepsia; Functional Constipation; Functional Diarrhea; Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome; Rumination; Achalasia; Diffuse Esophageal Spasm; Pelvic Floor Dysfunction; Gastroparesis.

Endocrine & Metabolic Disorders Hypothyroidism; Hyperthyroidism; Euthyroid Sick Syndrome; Hypopituitarism; Hyperprolactinemia; Adrenal Insufficiency; Cushing Syndrome; Hypoparathyroidism; Hyperparathyroidism; Polycystic Ovary Syndrome; Precocious Puberty; Delayed Puberty; Metabolic Syndrome.

Lipid & Inborn Metabolic Disorders Dyslipidemia; Hypercholesterolemia; Hypertriglyceridemia; Familial Hypercholesterolemia; Galactosemia; Phenylketonuria; Maple Syrup Urine Disease; Glycogen Storage Disease; Lysosomal Storage Disorders; Porphyria.

Electrolyte & Acid–Base Disorders Hyponatremia; Hypernatremia; Hypokalemia; Hyperkalemia; Hypocalcemia; Hypercalcemia; Hypomagnesemia; Hypermagnesemia; Hypophosphatemia; Hyperphosphatemia; Metabolic Acidosis; Metabolic Alkalosis; Respiratory Acidosis; Respiratory Alkalosis.

Bone Mineral Density Disorders Osteopenia; Osteoporosis; Osteomalacia; Renal Osteodystrophy; Fibrous Dysplasia; Paget Disease of Bone.

Musculoskeletal & Soft-Tissue Disorders Temporomandibular Joint Disorders; Rotator Cuff Tear; Rotator Cuff Injury; Herniated Disc; Degenerative Disc Disease; Myofascial Pain Syndrome; Tendinitis; Tendinopathy; Carpal Tunnel Syndrome; Cubital Tunnel Syndrome; Hypermobility Syndrome.

Blood & Coagulation Disorders Hemophilia A; Hemophilia B; Von Willebrand Disease; Thrombophilia; Glanzmann Thrombasthenia; Immune Thrombocytopenic Purpura; Aplastic Anemia; Myelodysplastic Syndrome.

Immune, Allergic & Eosinophilic Disorders Autoimmune Disease; Primary Immunodeficiency; Anaphylaxis; Angioedema; Mastocytosis; Eosinophilic Esophagitis; Eosinophilic Gastroenteritis.

Sexual Disorders Male Hypoactive Sexual Desire Disorder; Erectile Dysfunction; Premature Ejaculation; Delayed Ejaculation; Female Sexual Dysfunction; Female Orgasmic Disorder; Vaginismus; Dyspareunia; Gender Dysphoria.

Menstrual & Reproductive Disorders Dysmenorrhea; Amenorrhea; Abnormal Uterine Bleeding; Menorrhagia; Premenstrual Syndrome; Premenstrual Dysphoric Disorder; Anovulation; Premature Ovarian Insufficiency; Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome.

Urinary & Micturition Disorders Overactive Bladder; Urinary Incontinence; Stress Incontinence; Neurogenic Bladder; Urinary Retention; Bladder Outlet Obstruction.

Vision & Ocular Motility Disorders Refractive Disorder; Myopia; Hyperopia; Astigmatism; Presbyopia; Amblyopia; Strabismus; Color Vision Deficiency; Nystagmus; Dry Eye.

Hearing, Balance & Auditory Disorders Conductive Hearing Loss; Sensorineural Hearing Loss; Tinnitus; Auditory Processing Disorder; Benign Paroxysmal Positional Vertigo; Meniere Disease.

Speech, Language & Voice Disorders Language Disorder; Speech Disorder; Stuttering; Dysarthria; Apraxia; Aphasia; Voice Disorders; Dysphonia; Vocal Cord Dysfunction.

Hair, Nail & Pigmentation Disorders Alopecia; Alopecia Areata; Androgenetic Alopecia; Telogen Effluvium; Cicatricial Alopecia; Melasma; Vitiligo; Albinism.

Connective Tissue & Fascial Disorders Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome; Marfan Syndrome; Loeys-Dietz Syndrome; Mixed Connective Tissue Disease; Dupuytren Contracture; Plantar Fasciitis.

Mental Health Terms

Scope: This appendix groups commonly used mental-health terms for quick reference. It is an index, not a diagnostic or treatment guide. Preferred modern terms are used where an older or informal term may be misleading.

Foundations and assessment Acute; Affect; Chronic; Cognition; Diagnosis; Disorder; Distress; Functional Impairment; Mental Disorder; Mental Health; Mental Illness; Mood; Risk Factor; Syndrome.

Brain and nervous-system structures Amygdala; Axon; Brain; Brain Stem; Cerebellum; Cerebrum; Dendrite; Frontal Lobe; Gray Matter; Hippocampus; Hypothalamus; Limbic System; Locus Coeruleus; Myelin; Neuron; Neurotransmission; Neurotransmitter; Occipital Lobe; Parietal Lobe; Postsynaptic Membrane; Presynaptic Terminals; Receptor; Serotonin; Synapse; Temporal Lobe; Thalamus.

Common psychological and behavioral symptoms Anhedonia; Anxiety; Avolition; Cognitive Symptoms; Compulsions; Delusion; Euphoria; Obsessions; Panic Attack; Psychomotor Agitation; Psychomotor Retardation; Psychosis; Self-Harm; Stress; Trauma.

Anxiety, trauma, and obsessive-compulsive disorders Anxiety Disorders; Generalized Anxiety Disorder; Panic Disorder; Specific Phobia; Social Anxiety Disorder (Social Phobia); Separation Anxiety Disorder; Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder; Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder; Trichotillomania.

Mood disorders Bipolar Disorder; Bipolar II Disorder; Cyclothymic Disorder; Depression; Major Depressive Disorder; Major Depressive Episode; Persistent Depressive Disorder; Postpartum Depression; Seasonal Affective Disorder.

Psychotic and personality disorders Antisocial Personality Disorder; Borderline Personality Disorder; Narcissistic Personality Disorder; Personality Disorders; Brief Psychotic Disorder; Schizoaffective Disorder; Schizophrenia.

Neurodevelopmental and related conditions Conduct Disorder; Neurodevelopmental Disorders; Intellectual Disability; Neurocognitive Disorder; Functional Neurologic Disorder.

Psychiatric and psychological treatments Antidepressants; Antipsychotic Medicine; Atypical Antipsychotics; Benzodiazepine; Cognitive Behavioral Therapy; Dialectical Behavior Therapy; Electroconvulsive Therapy; Psychotherapy; Systematic Desensitization; Transcranial Magnetic Stimulation.

Care settings and professionals Community Mental-Health Treatment; Hospitalization; Psychiatry; Psychiatrist; Clinical Psychologist; Social Worker; Voluntary Psychiatric Admission.

Investigations and brain imaging Computed Tomography (CT); Electroencephalography; Functional MRI; Positron Emission Tomography; Single-Photon Emission Computed Tomography.

Suicide and safety terminology Suicidality; Suicide; Suicide Attempt; Suicidal Ideation; Suicidal Intent; Suicidal Plan; Suicide Risk Assessment.

Related scientific concepts Evidence-Based Practice; Neurosciences; Tolerance; Withdrawal.

Common Syndromes

Scope: This reference-oriented list organizes clinically significant medical syndromes by organ system and medical specialty. In medical terminology, a syndrome represents a characteristic constellation of concurrent signs, symptoms, or anatomical features that consistently occur together and point toward a common pathophysiological mechanism or etiology.

Cardiovascular Syndromes Acute Coronary Syndrome; Acute Aortic Syndrome; Sick Sinus Syndrome; Wolff–Parkinson–White Syndrome; Long QT Syndrome; Short QT Syndrome; Brugada Syndrome; Takotsubo Syndrome (Stress Cardiomyopathy); Eisenmenger Syndrome; Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome (POTS); Postpericardiotomy Syndrome; Dressler Syndrome; Cardiac Syndrome X; Cardiorenal Syndrome.

Respiratory Syndromes Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome (ARDS); Infant Respiratory Distress Syndrome; Obesity Hypoventilation Syndrome; Upper Airway Resistance Syndrome; Hepatopulmonary Syndrome; Acute Chest Syndrome; Kartagener Syndrome.

Gastrointestinal Syndromes Irritable Bowel Syndrome (IBS); Malabsorption Syndrome; Short Bowel Syndrome; Dumping Syndrome; Cyclic Vomiting Syndrome; Rumination Syndrome; Mallory–Weiss Syndrome; Zollinger–Ellison Syndrome; Boerhaave Syndrome; Afferent Loop Syndrome; Cannabinoid Hyperemesis Syndrome; Superior Mesenteric Artery Syndrome; Ogilvie Syndrome.

Liver & Biliary Syndromes Hepatorenal Syndrome; Hepatopulmonary Syndrome; Budd–Chiari Syndrome; Gilbert Syndrome; Crigler–Najjar Syndrome; Dubin–Johnson Syndrome; Rotor Syndrome; Reye Syndrome; Mirizzi Syndrome.

Kidney & Urinary Syndromes Nephrotic Syndrome; Nephritic Syndrome; Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome (HUS); Alport Syndrome; Fanconi Syndrome; Goodpasture Syndrome; Hepatorenal Syndrome; Nutcracker Syndrome.

Endocrine Syndromes Cushing Syndrome; Metabolic Syndrome; Syndrome of Inappropriate Antidiuretic Hormone Secretion (SIADH); Polycystic Ovary Syndrome (PCOS); Carcinoid Syndrome; Empty Sella Syndrome; Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome; Sheehan Syndrome; Nelson Syndrome; Polyglandular Autoimmune Syndromes (PAPS Type 1 and 2); Insulin Resistance Syndrome.

Neurological Syndromes Guillain–Barré Syndrome; Miller Fisher Syndrome; Lambert–Eaton Myasthenic Syndrome (LEMS); Restless Legs Syndrome; Locked-In Syndrome; Post-Concussion Syndrome; Cauda Equina Syndrome; Conus Medullaris Syndrome; Anterior Cord Syndrome; Central Cord Syndrome; Central Pain Syndrome; Alien Hand Syndrome; CADASIL Syndrome; Foix–Alajouanine Syndrome; Horner Syndrome; Tourette Syndrome; Lennox–Gastaut Syndrome; West Syndrome; Wernicke–Korsakoff Syndrome; Brown-Séquard Syndrome; Wallenberg Syndrome (Lateral Medullary Syndrome); Isaacs Syndrome.

Pain & Neuromuscular Syndromes Carpal Tunnel Syndrome; Cubital Tunnel Syndrome; Complex Regional Pain Syndrome (CRPS); Myofascial Pain Syndrome; Piriformis Syndrome; Compartment Syndrome; Thoracic Outlet Syndrome; Burning Mouth Syndrome; Tarsal Tunnel Syndrome; Greater Trochanteric Pain Syndrome.

Psychiatric & Behavioral Syndromes Serotonin Syndrome; Neuroleptic Malignant Syndrome; Capgras Syndrome; Cotard Syndrome; Münchausen Syndrome (Factitious Disorder); Korsakoff Syndrome; Amotivational Syndrome; Ekbom Syndrome (Delusional Parasitosis); Ganser Syndrome.

Rheumatologic & Autoimmune Syndromes Sjögren Syndrome; Antiphospholipid Syndrome; CREST Syndrome; Felty Syndrome; Behçet Syndrome; SAPHO Syndrome; Reactive Arthritis (formerly Reiter Syndrome); Churg–Strauss Syndrome (EGPA); Caplan Syndrome.

Hematological Syndromes Myelodysplastic Syndromes; Antiphospholipid Syndrome; Evans Syndrome; Hyperviscosity Syndrome; Tumor Lysis Syndrome; Hemophagocytic Syndrome (HLH); Acute Chest Syndrome; Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (TTP).

Immunological Syndromes Severe Combined Immunodeficiency Syndrome; Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS); Alpha-Gal Syndrome; Antisynthetase Syndrome; Capillary Leak Syndrome; Hyper-IgE Syndrome (Job Syndrome); Autoimmune Lymphoproliferative Syndrome (ALPS); Cytokine Release Syndrome (CRS); Immune Reconstitution Inflammatory Syndrome; Wiskott–Aldrich Syndrome.

Infectious & Postinfectious Syndromes Toxic Shock Syndrome (TSS); Post-COVID-19 Condition; Post-Polio Syndrome; Congenital Rubella Syndrome; Congenital Zika Syndrome; Waterhouse–Friderichsen Syndrome; Lemierre Syndrome.

Genetic & Chromosomal Syndromes Down Syndrome; Turner Syndrome; Klinefelter Syndrome; Edwards Syndrome; Patau Syndrome; DiGeorge Syndrome (22q11.2 Deletion); Fragile X Syndrome; Williams Syndrome; Prader–Willi Syndrome; Angelman Syndrome; Noonan Syndrome; Rett Syndrome; Cri-du-Chat Syndrome; Beckwith–Wiedemann Syndrome; McCune–Albright Syndrome.

Connective Tissue Syndromes Ehlers–Danlos Syndromes; Marfan Syndrome; Loeys–Dietz Syndrome; Stickler Syndrome; Joint Hypermobility Syndrome.

Pediatric Syndromes Down Syndrome; Fetal Alcohol Syndrome; Sudden Infant Death Syndrome (SIDS); Reye Syndrome; DiGeorge Syndrome; Beckwith–Wiedemann Syndrome; Nephrotic Syndrome; Hand-Foot-and-Mouth Syndrome.

Obstetric Syndromes HELLP Syndrome; Antiphospholipid Syndrome; Twin-to-Twin Transfusion Syndrome (TTTS); Amniotic Band Syndrome; Fetal Alcohol Syndrome.

Gynecological Syndromes Polycystic Ovary Syndrome; Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS); Asherman Syndrome; Genitourinary Syndrome of Menopause; Mayer–Rokitansky–Küster–Hauser (MRKH) Syndrome.

Male Reproductive Syndromes Klinefelter Syndrome; Androgen Insensitivity Syndrome; Kallmann Syndrome; Post-Vasectomy Pain Syndrome.

Cancer-Predisposition & Paraneoplastic Syndromes Lynch Syndrome (HNPCC); Li–Fraumeni Syndrome; Von Hippel–Lindau Syndrome; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN 1 and 2); Carcinoid Syndrome; Tumor Lysis Syndrome; Superior Vena Cava Syndrome; Paraneoplastic Neurological Syndromes; Cancer Cachexia Syndrome.

Metabolic & Nutritional Syndromes Metabolic Syndrome; Refeeding Syndrome; Wernicke–Korsakoff Syndrome; Milk-Alkali Syndrome; Hungry Bone Syndrome; Fanconi–Bickel Syndrome.

Toxicological Syndromes (Toxidromes) Serotonin Syndrome; Neuroleptic Malignant Syndrome; Anticholinergic Syndrome; Cholinergic Syndrome; Sympathomimetic Syndrome; Sedative-Hypnotic Syndrome; Opioid Withdrawal Syndrome; Alcohol Withdrawal Syndrome.

Critical Care Syndromes Systemic Inflammatory Response Syndrome (SIRS); Multiple Organ Dysfunction Syndrome (MODS); Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome (ARDS); Abdominal Compartment Syndrome; Fat Embolism Syndrome.

Sleep Syndromes Obstructive Sleep Apnea Syndrome; Central Sleep Apnea Syndromes; Restless Legs Syndrome; Kleine–Levin Syndrome; Delayed Sleep Phase Syndrome.

Eye & Cranial Nerve Syndromes Horner Syndrome; Adie Syndrome; Brown Syndrome; Duane Retraction Syndrome; Charles Bonnet Syndrome; Dry Eye Syndrome; Tolosa–Hunt Syndrome.

ENT & Otolaryngologic Syndromes Ramsay Hunt Syndrome; Eagle Syndrome; Empty Nose Syndrome; Gradenigo Syndrome; Samter Triad (Aspirin-Exacerbated Respiratory Disease).

Dermatological Syndromes Stevens–Johnson Syndrome; Toxic Epidermal Necrolysis; Staphylococcal Scalded Skin Syndrome; Sweet Syndrome; Gorlin Syndrome; Peutz–Jeghers Syndrome; DRESS Syndrome (Drug Reaction with Eosinophilia and Systemic Symptoms).

Vascular Syndromes Raynaud Syndrome; Superior Vena Cava Syndrome; Thoracic Outlet Syndrome; Subclavian Steal Syndrome; Leriche Syndrome; May–Thurner Syndrome; Nutcracker Syndrome.

Multisystem Syndromes Chronic Fatigue Syndrome (ME/CFS); Postural Orthostatic Tachycardia Syndrome (POTS); Ehlers–Danlos Syndromes; Metabolic Syndrome; Antiphospholipid Syndrome; Behcet Syndrome.

Rare Diseases

Scope: This reference-oriented list organizes clinically significant rare diseases (orphan diseases) by organ system and clinical domain. A rare disease is typically defined as one affecting fewer than 1 in 2,000 individuals (EU criteria) or fewer than 200,000 people in the United States. It highlights high-importance benchmark conditions characterized by distinct genetic, metabolic, or autoimmune etiologies.

Genetic & Chromosomal Diseases Turner Syndrome; Klinefelter Syndrome; Fragile X Syndrome; Williams Syndrome; Prader–Willi Syndrome; Angelman Syndrome; Noonan Syndrome; 22q11.2 Deletion Syndrome; Cri-du-Chat Syndrome; Hutchinson–Gilford Progeria Syndrome; Cornelia de Lange Syndrome.

Neurological & Neurogenetic Diseases Huntington Disease; Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis (ALS); Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA); Friedreich Ataxia; Ataxia–Telangiectasia; Rett Syndrome; Batten Disease (Neuronal Ceroid Lipofuscinosis); Creutzfeldt–Jakob Disease; Fatal Familial Insomnia; Progressive Supranuclear Palsy; Multiple System Atrophy; Stiff-Person Syndrome.

Neuromuscular & Peripheral Nerve Diseases Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy; Becker Muscular Dystrophy; Facioscapulohumeral Muscular Dystrophy; Limb-Girdle Muscular Dystrophies; Congenital Muscular Dystrophies; Myasthenia Gravis; Charcot–Marie–Tooth Disease; Amyloid Polyneuropathy.

Inborn Errors of Metabolism & Storage Diseases Gaucher Disease; Fabry Disease; Pompe Disease; Tay–Sachs Disease; Niemann–Pick Disease; Krabbe Disease; Metachromatic Leukodystrophy; X-Linked Adrenoleukodystrophy; Alkaptonuria; Homocystinuria; Phenylketonuria; Maple Syrup Urine Disease; Von Gierke Disease (GSD I); Mucopolysaccharidoses (Hurler, Hunter, Sanfilippo Syndromes).

Blood & Bone Marrow Diseases Hemophilia A; Hemophilia B; Paroxysmal Nocturnal Hemoglobinuria (PNH); Fanconi Anemia; Diamond–Blackfan Anemia; Pure Red Cell Aplasia; Thrombotic Thrombocytopenic Purpura (TTP); Atypical Hemolytic Uremic Syndrome; Cryoglobulinemia; Castleman Disease.

Immune, Autoinflammatory & Histiocytic Diseases Severe Combined Immunodeficiency (SCID); Common Variable Immunodeficiency; Chronic Granulomatous Disease; Wiskott–Aldrich Syndrome; Familial Mediterranean Fever; Cryopyrin-Associated Periodic Syndromes (CAPS); Hemophagocytic Lymphohistiocytosis (HLH); Histiocytosis X (Langerhans Cell Histiocytosis).

Rheumatologic & Autoimmune Diseases Systemic Sclerosis (Scleroderma); Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis; Microscopic Polyangiitis; Polyarteritis Nodosa; Behçet Disease; Takayasu Arteritis; Eosinophilic Granulomatosis with Polyangiitis (Churg–Strauss); Relapsing Polychondritis; Adult-Onset Still Disease.

Connective Tissue & Dermatological Genetic Diseases Ehlers–Danlos Syndromes (Vascular and Classic Types); Marfan Syndrome; Loeys–Dietz Syndrome; Osteogenesis Imperfecta; Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum; Epidermolysis Bullosa; Ichthyosis; Xeroderma Pigmentosum; Pemphigus Vulgaris; Bullous Pemphigoid.

Endocrine Diseases Addison Disease; Congenital Adrenal Hyperplasia; Acromegaly; Cushing Disease (Pituitary-Dependent); Hypoparathyroidism; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN 1 and 2); Pheochromocytoma; Autoimmune Polyglandular Syndromes.

Hepatic & Biliary Diseases Wilson Disease; Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency; Primary Biliary Cholangitis; Primary Sclerosing Cholangitis; Biliary Atresia; Progressive Familial Intrahepatic Cholestasis; Caroli Disease.

Renal & Urinary Diseases Alport Syndrome; Cystinosis; Primary Hyperoxaluria; Bartter Syndrome; Gitelman Syndrome; Polycystic Kidney Disease (Autosomal Recessive Type); Medullary Cystic Kidney Disease.

Pulmonary Diseases Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis; Pulmonary Arterial Hypertension; Lymphangioleiomyomatosis (LAM); Pulmonary Alveolar Proteinosis; Primary Ciliary Dyskinesia.

Cardiovascular Diseases Brugada Syndrome; Long QT Syndrome; Short QT Syndrome; Arrhythmogenic Right Ventricular Cardiomyopathy; Fibromuscular Dysplasia; Takayasu Arteritis.

Gastrointestinal Diseases Hirschsprung Disease; Achalasia; Eosinophilic Esophagitis; Short Bowel Syndrome; Hereditary Pancreatitis; Microvillus Inclusion Disease.

Eye & Visual Pathway Diseases Retinitis Pigmentosa; Stargardt Disease; Leber Hereditary Optic Neuropathy; Leber Congenital Amaurosis; Retinoblastoma; Aniridia; Best Disease.

Bone, Skeletal & Cartilage Diseases Achondroplasia; Fibrodysplasia Ossificans Progressiva (FOP); Hypophosphatasia; Osteopetrosis (Marble Bone Disease); Cleidocranial Dysplasia; Thanatophoric Dysplasia.

Rare Infectious & Prion Diseases Creutzfeldt–Jakob Disease; Variant CJD; Kuru; Whipple Disease; Progressive Multifocal Leukoencephalopathy (PML); Ebola Virus Disease; Marburg Virus Disease; Lassa Fever.

Rare Cancers & Neoplasms Malignant Mesothelioma; Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor (GIST); Neuroendocrine Tumors; Ewing Sarcoma; Osteosarcoma; Retinoblastoma; Uveal Melanoma; Adrenocortical Carcinoma; Thymoma; Merkel Cell Carcinoma; Kaposi Sarcoma; Burkitt Lymphoma.

Multisystem & Inflammatory Diseases Erdheim–Chester Disease; POEMS Syndrome; VEXAS Syndrome; IgG4-Related Disease; Systemic Amyloidosis; Castleman Disease.

Genetic Diseases

Scope: This reference-oriented list organizes human genetic diseases by mode of inheritance, cytogenetic classification, and molecular pathophysiological mechanism. Genetic diseases result from alterations in DNA sequences, ranging from single-nucleotide variants to gross chromosomal rearrangements and non-Mendelian mechanisms, providing a focused reference complementing Common Diseases and Rare Diseases.

Autosomal Dominant Diseases Huntington Disease; Marfan Syndrome; Neurofibromatosis Type 1 (von Recklinghausen Disease); Neurofibromatosis Type 2; Familial Hypercholesterolemia; Polycystic Kidney Disease (Autosomal Dominant, ADPKD); Achondroplasia; Tuberous Sclerosis Complex; Hereditary Spherocytosis; Von Hippel–Lindau Syndrome; Li–Fraumeni Syndrome; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN 1 and 2); Myotonic Dystrophy (Type 1 and 2); Hereditary Non-Polyposis Colorectal Cancer (Lynch Syndrome); Familial Adenomatous Polyposis (FAP); Osteogenesis Imperfecta (Type I); Ehlers–Danlos Syndrome (Hypermobile and Classic Types).

Autosomal Recessive Diseases Cystic Fibrosis; Sickle-Cell Disease; Beta-Thalassemia; Alpha-Thalassemia; Phenylketonuria (PKU); Gaucher Disease; Tay–Sachs Disease; Niemann–Pick Disease; Wilson Disease; Hereditary Hemochromatosis; Alpha-1 Antitrypsin Deficiency; Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA); Friedreich Ataxia; Alkaptonuria; Homocystinuria; Maple Syrup Urine Disease; Congenital Adrenal Hyperplasia; Galactosemia; Glycogen Storage Diseases (von Gierke, Pompe, Cori); Ataxia–Telangiectasia; Fanconi Anemia; Xeroderma Pigmentosum; Bloom Syndrome; Ellis–van Creveld Syndrome; Kartagener Syndrome.

X-Linked Recessive Diseases Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy; Becker Muscular Dystrophy; Hemophilia A (Factor VIII Deficiency); Hemophilia B (Factor IX Deficiency); Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase (G6PD) Deficiency; Red-Green Color Blindness; Fragile X Syndrome; Lesch–Nyhan Syndrome; Wiskott–Aldrich Syndrome; X-Linked Agammaglobulinemia (Bruton Tyrosine Kinase Deficiency); X-Linked Adrenoleukodystrophy; Hunter Syndrome (MPS II); Fabry Disease; Menkes Disease; Alport Syndrome (X-Linked Type); Chronic Granulomatous Disease (X-Linked Form).

X-Linked Dominant Diseases Rett Syndrome (MECP2 Mutation); Incontinentia Pigmenti; X-Linked Hypophosphatemic Rickets; Aicardi Syndrome; Focal Dermal Hypoplasia (Goltz Syndrome); Fragile X-Associated Tremor/Ataxia Syndrome (FXTAS).

Y-Linked (Holandric) Conditions Y-Chromosome Infertility (AZF Deletions); SRY Gene Deletions/Mutations; Swyer Syndrome (46,XY Gonadal Dysgenesis); Retinitis Pigmentosa (Y-Linked Form); Hypertrichosis Pinnae Auris.

Mitochondrial (Maternal) Genetic Diseases Leber Hereditary Optic Neuropathy (LHON); Mitochondrial Encephalomyopathy, Lactic Acidosis, and Stroke-Like Episodes (MELAS); Myoclonic Epilepsy with Ragged Red Fibers (MERRF); Neuropathy, Ataxia, and Retinitis Pigmentosa (NARP); Leigh Syndrome (Subacute Necrotizing Encephalomyelopathy); Kearns–Sayre Syndrome; Pearson Syndrome; Chronic Progressive External Ophthalmoplegia (CPEO).

Chromosomal Aneuploidies (Autosomal) Trisomy 21 (Down Syndrome); Trisomy 18 (Edwards Syndrome); Trisomy 13 (Patau Syndrome); Trisomy 8 (Warkany Syndrome 2); Trisomy 9 Mosaicism.

Sex Chromosome Aneuploidies 45,X (Turner Syndrome); 47,XXY (Klinefelter Syndrome); 47,XXX (Triple X Syndrome); 47,XYY (Jacob Syndrome); 48,XXYY Syndrome; 48,XXXY Syndrome; Tetrasomy X.

Microdeletion & Microduplication Syndromes 22q11.2 Deletion Syndrome (DiGeorge Syndrome, Velocardiofacial Syndrome); 5p Deletion Syndrome (Cri-du-Chat Syndrome); 4p Deletion Syndrome (Wolf–Hirschhorn Syndrome); 7q11.23 Deletion Syndrome (Williams Syndrome); 17p11.2 Deletion Syndrome (Smith–Magenis Syndrome); 17p11.2 Duplication Syndrome (Potocki–Lupski Syndrome); 1p36 Deletion Syndrome; 15q11–q13 Deletion; Rubinstein–Taybi Syndrome.

Genomic Imprinting Disorders Prader–Willi Syndrome (Maternal Imprinting / Paternal 15q11–q13 Loss); Angelman Syndrome (Paternal Imprinting / Maternal UBE3A Loss); Beckwith–Wiedemann Syndrome (11p15.5 Alteration); Silver–Russell Syndrome; Pseudohypoparathyroidism (Albright Hereditary Osteodystrophy); Uniparental Disomy Syndromes.

Trinucleotide Repeat Expansion Diseases Huntington Disease (CAG Repeat); Fragile X Syndrome (CGG Repeat); Myotonic Dystrophy Type 1 (CTG Repeat); Friedreich Ataxia (GAA Repeat); Spinocerebellar Ataxias (SCA Types 1, 2, 3, 6, 7); Dentatorubral-Pallidoluysian Atrophy (DRPLA); Spinal and Bulbar Muscular Atrophy (Kennedy Disease).

Lysosomal Storage Diseases Gaucher Disease (Glucocerebrosidase Deficiency); Tay–Sachs Disease (Hexosaminidase A Deficiency); Niemann–Pick Disease (Types A, B, C); Fabry Disease (Alpha-Galactosidase A Deficiency); Pompe Disease (Acid Alpha-Glucosidase Deficiency); Krabbe Disease; Metachromatic Leukodystrophy; Mucopolysaccharidoses (Hurler, Scheie, Hunter, Sanfilippo, Morquio, Maroteaux–Lamy, Sly Syndromes); Fucosidosis; Sialidosis.

Connective Tissue Genetic Disorders Marfan Syndrome (FBN1 Mutation); Ehlers–Danlos Syndromes; Loeys–Dietz Syndrome; Osteogenesis Imperfecta (Brittle Bone Disease); Cutis Laxa; Stickler Syndrome; Pseudoxanthoma Elasticum; Alport Syndrome.

Hereditary Cancer Predisposition Syndromes Hereditary Breast and Ovarian Cancer Syndrome (BRCA1, BRCA2); Lynch Syndrome (MLH1, MSH2, MSH6, PMS2); Familial Adenomatous Polyposis (APC Mutation); Li–Fraumeni Syndrome (TP53 Mutation); Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia Types 1, 2A, 2B; Von Hippel–Lindau Disease; Cowden Syndrome (PTEN Hamartoma Tumor Syndrome); Peutz–Jeghers Syndrome; Nevoid Basal Cell Carcinoma Syndrome (Gorlin Syndrome); Retinoblastoma (RB1 Mutation); Wilms Tumor Predisposition (WT1).

Inherited Diseases

Classification: The first groups show the most common inheritance pattern. The later clinical categories overlap, and several conditions have rare alternate patterns or genetically heterogeneous forms.

Autosomal Dominant Achondroplasia; Autosomal Dominant Polycystic Kidney Disease (ADPKD); Familial Adenomatous Polyposis; Familial Hypercholesterolemia; Hereditary Angioedema (most forms); Huntington Disease; Marfan Syndrome; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia; Neurofibromatosis Type 1; Neurofibromatosis Type 2; Tuberous Sclerosis Complex; Von Hippel–Lindau Disease.

Autosomal Recessive Alpha-Thalassemia; Beta-Mannosidosis; Beta-Thalassemia; Congenital Adrenal Hyperplasia; Cystic Fibrosis; Familial Mediterranean Fever; Gaucher Disease; Hemochromatosis; Phenylketonuria (PKU); Sickle-Cell Disease; Spinal Muscular Atrophy; Tay–Sachs Disease; Wilson Disease.

X-Linked Becker Muscular Dystrophy; Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy; Fragile X Syndrome; Glucose-6-Phosphate Dehydrogenase (G6PD) Deficiency; Hemophilia A; Hemophilia B; X-Linked Agammaglobulinemia.

Variable or Genetically Heterogeneous Alport Syndrome (X-linked, autosomal dominant, or autosomal recessive); Charcot–Marie–Tooth Disease (multiple inheritance patterns); Hereditary Spherocytosis (usually autosomal dominant, sometimes autosomal recessive); Retinitis Pigmentosa (autosomal dominant, autosomal recessive, X-linked, or mitochondrial); Von Willebrand Disease (usually autosomal dominant, with some autosomal recessive forms).

Mitochondrial MELAS; MERRF; Leber Hereditary Optic Neuropathy (LHON).

Inherited Metabolic Disorders Maple Syrup Urine Disease; Galactosemia; Homocystinuria; Glycogen Storage Diseases; Lysosomal Storage Diseases; Urea-Cycle Disorders.

Inherited Neurological or Neuromuscular Disorders Charcot–Marie–Tooth Disease; Spinal Muscular Atrophy; Hereditary Spastic Paraplegia; Friedreich Ataxia.

Inherited Blood Disorders Sickle-Cell Disease; Alpha-Thalassemia; Beta-Thalassemia; Hereditary Spherocytosis; Hemophilia A; Hemophilia B; some forms of Von Willebrand Disease.

Inherited Connective-Tissue or Skeletal Disorders Osteogenesis Imperfecta; Ehlers–Danlos Syndromes; Marfan Syndrome; Achondroplasia.

Inherited Renal Disorders Alport Syndrome; Autosomal Dominant Polycystic Kidney Disease (ADPKD); Autosomal Recessive Polycystic Kidney Disease (ARPKD); Cystinuria.

Inherited Eye Disorders Retinitis Pigmentosa; Stargardt Disease; congenital color-vision deficiencies; some forms of congenital cataract.

Hereditary Cancer Syndromes Lynch Syndrome; Familial Adenomatous Polyposis; Hereditary Breast and Ovarian Cancer Syndrome; Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia (MEN) Syndromes; Li–Fraumeni Syndrome; Von Hippel–Lindau Disease.

Common Symptoms

Scope: For a medical dictionary or disease-reference project, symptoms are best organized by body system, because a flat alphabetical list quickly becomes difficult to use. Here is a broad list of common medical symptoms.

General / Systemic Fatigue; Weakness; Malaise; Fever; Chills; Night Sweats; Excessive Sweating; Hot Flashes; Flushing; Loss of Appetite; Increased Appetite; Unexplained Weight Loss; Unexplained Weight Gain; Excessive Thirst; Dehydration; Exercise Intolerance; Lethargy; Generalized Body Aches.

Pain Headache; Chest Pain; Pleuritic Chest Pain; Abdominal Pain; Cramping or Colicky Pain; Back Pain; Neck Pain; Joint Pain; Muscle Pain; Bone Pain; Pelvic Pain; Flank Pain; Facial Pain; Eye Pain; Earache; Sore Throat; Toothache; Painful Urination; Rectal Pain; Burning Pain; Radiating Pain; Throbbing Pain.

Neurological Dizziness; Vertigo; Fainting; Light-Headedness; Orthostatic Lightheadedness; Numbness; Tingling; Burning Sensation; Electric Shock Sensations; Tremor; Muscle Weakness; Paralysis; Seizures; Confusion; Memory Problems; Forgetfulness; Difficulty Concentrating; Brain Fog; Loss of Balance; Poor Coordination; Slurred Speech; Altered Consciousness; Aura.

Eye / Vision Blurred Vision; Double Vision; Loss of Vision; Reduced Visual Acuity; Night Blindness; Eye Redness; Watery Eyes; Dry Eyes; Gritty or Foreign-Body Sensation; Eye Strain; Itchy Eyes; Photophobia; Floaters; Flashes of Light; Halos Around Lights; Sensitivity to Glare.

Ear / Hearing Hearing Loss; Tinnitus; Ear Discharge; Ear Fullness; Ear Pain; Sensitivity to Sound; Popping or Clicking in Ears.

Nose / Sinus Runny Nose; Nasal Congestion; Sneezing; Nosebleed; Loss of Smell; Reduced Smell; Sinus Pressure; Postnasal Drip; Frequent Throat Clearing.

Mouth / Throat Dry Mouth; Mouth Ulcers; Bad Breath; Altered Taste; Loss of Taste; Bleeding Gums; Hoarseness; Sore Throat; Difficulty Swallowing; Painful Swallowing; Lump in Throat; Burning Mouth Sensation.

Respiratory Cough; Dry Cough; Productive Cough; Coughing up Blood; Shortness of Breath; Shortness of Breath on Exertion; Wheezing; Rapid Breathing; Noisy Breathing; Sputum Production; Chest Tightness; Air Hunger; Choking Sensation; Inability to Take a Deep Breath.

Cardiovascular Palpitations; Rapid Heartbeat; Slow Heartbeat; Irregular Heartbeat; Heart Fluttering; Chest Pressure; Chest Squeezing; Shortness of Breath on Exertion; Orthopnea; Paroxysmal Nocturnal Dyspnea; Fainting; Ankle or Leg Swelling; Cold Extremities; Intermittent Claudication; Cyanosis.

Gastrointestinal Nausea; Vomiting; Vomiting Blood; Heartburn; Acid Regurgitation; Indigestion; Bloating; Abdominal Distension; Abdominal Cramps; Excessive Gas; Belching; Difficulty Passing Gas; Diarrhea; Constipation; Straining at Stool; Tenesmus; Blood in Stool; Black or Tarry Stool; Mucus in Stool; Fecal Urgency; Fecal Incontinence; Early Satiety; Anal Itching.

Urinary Frequent Urination; Urinary Urgency; Painful Urination; Excessive Urination; Reduced Urination; Inability to Urinate; Urinary Hesitancy; Post-Void Dribbling; Nighttime Urination; Blood in Urine; Urinary Incontinence; Weak Urinary Stream; Bladder Spasms; Foamy Urine.

Musculoskeletal Joint Stiffness; Morning Stiffness; Joint Swelling; Reduced Range of Motion; Joint Clicking or Grating; Joint Instability or Giving Way; Muscle Cramps; Muscle Spasms; Muscle Stiffness; Muscle Twitches; Restless Legs Sensation; Limb Pain; Difficulty Walking; Limping.

Skin Itching; Rash; Redness; Dry Skin; Scaling or Flaking; Skin Discoloration; Bruising; Easy Bruisability; Swelling; Hives; Blisters; Skin Ulcers; Lumps; Excessive Sweating; Reduced Sweating; Hair Loss; Hair Shedding; Brittle Nails; Crawling Sensation on Skin; Skin Tenderness.

Endocrine / Metabolic Excessive Thirst; Excessive Hunger; Frequent Urination; Heat Intolerance; Cold Intolerance; Unexplained Weight Change; Excessive Sweating; Hot Flashes.

Sleep-Related Insomnia; Difficulty Falling Asleep; Difficulty Staying Asleep; Frequent Awakening; Early Morning Awakening; Non-Restorative Sleep; Excessive Daytime Sleepiness; Snoring; Gasping in Sleep; Restless Sleep; Nightmares; Sleepwalking.

Psychological / Behavioral Anxiety; Depressed Mood; Irritability; Agitation; Mood Changes; Loss of Interest or Pleasure; Poor Concentration; Racing Thoughts; Restlessness; Sleep Disturbance; Appetite Changes; Feeling Detached.

Reproductive / Gynecological Pelvic Pain; Painful Menstruation; Heavy Menstrual Bleeding; Irregular Menstruation; Missed Periods; Vaginal Discharge; Vaginal Bleeding; Bleeding Between Periods; Vaginal Itching; Painful Intercourse; Hot Flashes.

Male Reproductive Erectile Dysfunction; Reduced Libido; Testicular Pain; Testicular Swelling; Penile Discharge; Painful Ejaculation; Scrotal Heaviness.

Blood / Lymphatic Easy Bruising; Prolonged Bleeding; Pale Skin; Swollen Lymph Nodes; Recurrent Infections; Petechiae.

Allergic Itching; Sneezing; Watery Eyes; Nasal Congestion; Hives; Facial Swelling; Lip or Tongue Swelling; Wheezing; Shortness of Breath; Anaphylactic Reactions Sensation.

Clinical Note: For a comprehensive medical dictionary, it is essential to distinguish symptoms (subjective experiences reported by the patient, such as nausea or pain) from clinical signs (objectively observed physical findings detected on examination, such as jaundice, edema, or tachycardia). Mixing them is common in general health lists, but an authoritative reference maintains clear separation among Symptoms, Clinical Signs, Syndromes, and Diseases/Disorders categories.

Clinical Signs

Scope: A clinical sign is an objective abnormality that can be observed, measured, elicited, or detected by a clinician, unlike a symptom, which is experienced and reported by the patient. For a medical dictionary, the following system-based classification is useful.

General / Vital Signs Fever; Hypothermia; Tachycardia; Bradycardia; Tachypnea; Bradypnea; Hypertension; Hypotension; Orthostatic Hypotension; Pulsus Paradoxus; Wide Pulse Pressure; Narrow Pulse Pressure; Hypoxemia; Central Cyanosis; Peripheral Cyanosis; Altered Level of Consciousness; Cachexia; Pallor; Jaundice; Dehydration; Pitting Edema; Non-Pitting Edema; Generalized Lymphadenopathy; Clubbing.

Skin Signs Erythema; Pallor; Cyanosis; Jaundice; Petechiae; Purpura; Ecchymosis; Spider Angiomas; Palmar Erythema; Splinter Hemorrhages; Osler Nodes; Janeway Lesions; Rash; Urticaria; Vesicles; Bullae; Pustules; Papules; Nodules; Ulcers; Scaling; Excoriations; Lichenification; Skin Thickening; Hyperpigmentation; Hypopigmentation; Alopecia; Diaphoresis; Reduced Skin Turgor.

Head & Face Signs Facial Asymmetry; Facial Edema; Ptosis; Proptosis; Moon Facies; Mask-Like Facies; Temporal Wasting; Kayser-Fleischer Rings; Arcus Senilis; Xanthelasma; Subconjunctival Hemorrhage.

Eye Signs Conjunctival Pallor; Conjunctival Injection; Scleral Icterus; Anisocoria; Nystagmus; Strabismus; Ptosis; Proptosis; Papilledema; Absent Pupillary Reflex; Abnormal Red Reflex; Corneal Opacity; Roth Spots; Argyll Robertson Pupil.

Ear, Nose & Throat Signs Tympanic Membrane Erythema; Tympanic Membrane Perforation; Otorrhea; Nasal Polyps; Epistaxis; Tonsillar Enlargement; Tonsillar Exudate; Pharyngeal Erythema; Oral Ulcers; Oral Thrush; Strawberry Tongue; Coated Tongue; Koplik Spots; Gingival Hyperplasia; Peritonsillar Bulge; Deviated Uvula.

Neck Signs Cervical Lymphadenopathy; Goiter; Thyroid Nodule; Neck Stiffness; Elevated Jugular Venous Pressure; Carotid Bruit; Tracheal Deviation; Pemberton Sign.

Cardiovascular Signs Tachycardia; Bradycardia; Irregular Pulse; Weak Pulse; Bounding Pulse; Pulsus Alternans; Corrigan Pulse; Water-Hammer Pulse; Pulse Deficit; Displaced Apex Beat; Heart Murmur; Systolic Murmur; Diastolic Murmur; Gallop Rhythm; Third Heart Sound; Fourth Heart Sound; Pericardial Friction Rub; Cardiac Thrill; Ventricular Heave; Elevated Jugular Venous Pressure; Peripheral Edema; Delayed Capillary Refill.

Respiratory Signs Tachypnea; Bradypnea; Apnea; Cyanosis; Accessory-Muscle Use; Nasal Flaring; Chest Retractions; Barrel Chest; Pectus Excavatum; Pectus Carinatum; Asymmetric Chest Expansion; Subcutaneous Emphysema; Reduced Air Entry; Wheezing; Crackles; Rhonchi; Stridor; Bronchial Breath Sounds; Dullness to Percussion; Hyperresonance; Pleural Friction Rub.

Abdominal & Gastrointestinal Signs Abdominal Distension; Abdominal Tenderness; Guarding; Rigidity; Rebound Tenderness; Shifting Dullness; Fluid Wave; Caput Medusae; Palpable Abdominal Mass; Hepatomegaly; Splenomegaly; Ascites; Succussion Splash; Abnormal Bowel Sounds; Abdominal Bruit; Visible Peristalsis; Rectal Bleeding; Melena.

Neurological Signs Altered Consciousness; Disorientation; Abnormal Gait; Festinating Gait; Spastic Hemiplegic Gait; Ataxia; Tremor; Asterixis; Fasciculations; Muscle Wasting; Pronator Drift; Cogwheel Rigidity; Lead-Pipe Rigidity; Abnormal Muscle Tone; Hyperreflexia; Hyporeflexia; Areflexia; Pathological Reflexes; Clonus; Dysmetria; Dysdiadochokinesia; Sensory Deficit; Motor Weakness on Examination; Cranial Nerve Deficit; Nystagmus; Neck Rigidity.

Musculoskeletal Signs Joint Swelling; Joint Deformity; Joint Effusion; Restricted Range of Motion; Crepitus; Muscle Wasting; Muscle Spasm; Heberden Nodes; Bouchard Nodes; Swan-Neck Deformity; Boutonniere Deformity; Baker Cyst; Limb Deformity; Abnormal Posture; Scoliosis; Kyphosis; Lordosis; Abnormal Gait.

Renal & Urinary Signs Bladder Distension; Costovertebral-Angle Tenderness; Peripheral Edema; Hematuria on Testing; Proteinuria; Oliguria; Anuria.

Endocrine Signs Goiter; Exophthalmos; Tremor; Abnormal Hair Distribution; Hirsutism; Striae; Acanthosis Nigricans; Moon Facies; Buffalo Hump; Peripheral Edema.

Hematological Signs Pallor; Petechiae; Purpura; Ecchymoses; Generalized Lymphadenopathy; Splenomegaly; Hepatomegaly; Active Bleeding.

Peripheral Vascular Signs Peripheral Edema; Pitting Edema; Varicose Veins; Absent or Diminished Peripheral Pulses; Cool Extremities; Delayed Capillary Refill; Venous Ulcers; Arterial Ulcers; Peripheral Cyanosis.

Gynecological Signs Abnormal Vaginal Bleeding on Examination; Vaginal or Cervical Discharge; Cervical Lesions; Pelvic Mass; Uterine Enlargement; Adnexal Mass; Cervical-Motion Tenderness; Chandelier Sign.

Male Genital Signs Testicular Swelling; Testicular Mass; Scrotal Edema; Penile Discharge; Genital Ulceration; Phimosis; Hydrocele; Varicocele.

Pediatric & Neonatal Signs Poor Weight Gain on Growth Charts; Growth Retardation; Bulging Fontanelle; Sunken Fontanelle; Neonatal Jaundice; Central Cyanosis; Chest Retractions; Abnormal Primitive Reflexes; Gowers Sign.

Named Clinical Signs Babinski Sign; Murphy Sign; Kernig Sign; Brudzinski Sign; Rovsing Sign; Cullen Sign; Grey Turner Sign; Trousseau Sign; Chvostek Sign; Romberg Sign; Hoffmann Sign; Courvoisier Sign; Kussmaul Sign; Battle Sign; Nikolsky Sign; Auspitz Sign; Ortolani Sign; Barlow Sign; Trendelenburg Sign; McBurney Sign; Tinel Sign; Phalen Sign; Lhermitte Sign; Blumberg Sign; Kehr Sign; Hamman Sign; Homans Sign; Psoas Sign; Obturator Sign; Lachman Sign; Anterior Drawer Sign.

Clinical Note: A comprehensive medical reference can contain 500–1,000+ clinical signs, encompassing physical examination findings, named signs, dermatological signs, radiological signs, and laboratory markers.

Common Congenital Anomalies

Scope: A congenital anomaly is a structural abnormality present at birth, whether genetic, chromosomal, or environmental in origin. This list complements the appendices of Common Diseases, Common Disorders, and Common Syndromes.

Orofacial & Head Anomalies Cleft Lip; Cleft Palate.

Neural Tube & Brain Anomalies Spina Bifida; Anencephaly; Encephalocele; Hydrocephalus.

Thorax & Abdominal Wall Anomalies Congenital Diaphragmatic Hernia; Omphalocele; Gastroschisis.

Digestive System Anomalies Imperforate Anus; Hirschsprung Disease.

Urinary & Genital Anomalies Hypospadias; Epispadias.

Limb & Skeletal Anomalies Clubfoot; Developmental Dysplasia of the Hip; Polydactyly; Syndactyly.

Eye Anomalies Congenital Cataract.

Heart & Great-Vessel Anomalies Congenital Heart Defects; Ventricular Septal Defect; Atrial Septal Defect; Patent Ductus Arteriosus; Tetralogy of Fallot; Coarctation of the Aorta.

Common Findings, Lesions & Conditions

Scope: This companion list collects clinical findings, structural lesions, symptom patterns, and obstetric events that are not diseases in themselves but are frequently encountered in clinical work, imaging, and laboratory testing. It complements the appendices of Common Diseases, Common Disorders, and Common Syndromes.

Cardiovascular & Respiratory Findings Pericardial Effusion; Pleural Effusion; Pneumothorax; Hemothorax; Atelectasis.

Abdominal & Pancreatic Findings Esophageal Varices; Gallstones; Biliary Obstruction; Cholestasis; Pancreatic Pseudocyst; Pancreatic Cysts; Pancreatic Necrosis.

Renal & Urinary Findings Kidney Stones; Hydronephrosis.

Head, Neck & Airway Findings Thyroid Nodules; Nasal Polyps; Deviated Nasal Septum; Vocal-Cord Nodules; Earwax Impaction; Tympanic Membrane Perforation.

Oral & Dental Findings Tooth Erosion; Impacted Teeth; Malocclusion; Geographic Tongue.

Eye & Skin Findings Chalazion; Stye; Keloids; Ingrown Toenail.

Genital & Reproductive Findings Ovarian Cysts; Bartholin Cyst; Varicocele; Hydrocele; Spermatocele.

Pain & Symptom Conditions Low-Back Pain; Sciatica.

Metabolic Risk & Allergic States Prediabetes; Anaphylaxis.

Obstetric & Labor Events Ectopic Pregnancy; Miscarriage; Recurrent Pregnancy Loss; Placenta Previa; Placental Abruption; Placenta Accreta Spectrum; Premature Rupture of Membranes; Preterm Labor; Fetal Growth Restriction; Obstructed Labor; Postpartum Hemorrhage.

Common Injuries, Poisoning & Environmental Conditions

Scope: This companion list covers injuries (trauma), poisoning and envenomation, and adverse effects of environmental exposure and extremes. These are events or conditions rather than diseases; it complements the appendices of Common Diseases, Common Disorders, and Common Syndromes.

Bone, Joint & Muscle Injuries Fracture; Dislocation; Sprain; Strain.

Skin & Soft-Tissue Injuries Contusion; Laceration; Abrasion; Crush Injury.

Nervous-System Injuries Traumatic Brain Injury; Concussion; Spinal-Cord Injury.

Thermal & Electrical Injuries Burns; Electrical Injury; Hypothermia; Frostbite; Heat Exhaustion; Heatstroke.

Environmental Conditions Drowning; Dehydration; Altitude Sickness; Motion Sickness.

Poisoning & Envenomation Carbon Monoxide Poisoning; Lead Poisoning; Mercury Poisoning; Arsenic Poisoning; Pesticide Poisoning; Snakebite; Scorpion Sting.

Drug & Alcohol Overdose Drug Overdose; Alcohol Poisoning.

Conditions That May Be Asymptomatic

Scope: This reference list groups diseases, infections, and other conditions that may be present without noticeable symptoms, particularly during early, latent, or compensated stages. Being asymptomatic is a clinical state or mode of presentation rather than a separate category of disease, so every condition here also belongs under its usual organ-system or specialty heading, and "May be asymptomatic" is best treated as an attribute or tag in addition to that classification. Many of these conditions cause symptoms in some people and none in others, and some come to attention only through screening or when a complication appears. The list is a curated, high-importance reference rather than a prevalence ranking, and some conditions appear under more than one heading where they are clinically relevant to several systems. Individual symptoms, signs, and laboratory findings are defined as dictionary entries rather than listed here.

Important distinction: "Asymptomatic disease" is not a distinct disease; it describes how a disease presents. Hypertension is a cardiovascular disease that is often asymptomatic, chlamydia is an infection that is frequently asymptomatic, osteoporosis is a skeletal disease that is typically asymptomatic until a fracture, and open-angle glaucoma is an eye disease that is often asymptomatic in its early stages.

Cardiovascular Hypertension; Atherosclerosis; Coronary Artery Disease; Peripheral Artery Disease; Some Arrhythmias; Early Valvular Heart Disease

Metabolic & Endocrine Prediabetes; Early Type 2 Diabetes; Dyslipidemia; Subclinical Hypothyroidism; Subclinical Hyperthyroidism; Hyperuricemia

Kidney & Urinary Early Chronic Kidney Disease; Diabetic Kidney Disease; Mild Proteinuria; Microscopic Hematuria; Some Kidney Stones

Liver Metabolic Dysfunction-Associated Steatotic Liver Disease (MASLD); Chronic Hepatitis B; Chronic Hepatitis C; Early Cirrhosis; Hemochromatosis

Infectious HIV Infection During Clinical Latency; Hepatitis B; Hepatitis C; Chlamydia; Gonorrhea; HPV Infection; Latent Tuberculosis Infection; Some COVID-19 Infections

Cancer & Precancer Early Colorectal Cancer; Cervical Precancer; Early Cervical Cancer; Early Prostate Cancer; Early Kidney Cancer; Some Thyroid Cancers; Early Breast Cancer

Gynecological HPV Infection; Some Ovarian Cysts; Uterine Fibroids; Early Cervical Abnormalities; Some Sexually Transmitted Infections

Male Reproductive Early Prostate Cancer; Some Sexually Transmitted Infections; Varicocele; Some Cases of Benign Prostatic Enlargement

Blood Mild Anemia; Monoclonal Gammopathy of Undetermined Significance (MGUS); Early Chronic Leukemia; Mild Thrombocytopenia

Bone Osteoporosis; Osteopenia

Eye Open-Angle Glaucoma; Early Diabetic Retinopathy; Early Age-Related Macular Degeneration

Neurological & Vascular Silent Cerebral Infarction; Asymptomatic Carotid Stenosis; Some Unruptured Intracranial Aneurysms

Gastrointestinal Diverticulosis; Colon Polyps; Some Gallstones; Some Hiatal Hernias

Gallbladder Asymptomatic Gallstones ("Silent Gallstones"); Gallbladder Polyps

Genetic Hemochromatosis Before Organ Damage; Some Inherited Thrombophilias; Some Genetic Carrier States

Parasitic & Latent Infections Some Malaria Infections; Intestinal Parasitic Infections; Toxoplasmosis and Other Latent Infections

Lay Language Medical Terms

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Belly area	ABDOMEN/ABDOMINAL	The body cavity below the diaphragm containing the stomach, intestines, liver, and other organs.
Take in	ABSORB	To take up or take in a substance, such as fluid.
Too much acid in blood	ACIDOSIS	A condition in which the blood is more acidic than normal.
Sharpness or clarity	ACUITY	The clearness or keenness of a sense, especially vision.
Recent or sudden	ACUTE	New, recent, sudden, or requiring urgent attention.
Swollen glands	ADENOPATHY	Enlarged or swollen lymph nodes.
Helpful added treatment	ADJUVANT	Something that supports or assists the main treatment.
Added treatment	ADJUVANT TREATMENT	Treatment given in addition to the main or standard treatment.
Germ-killing drug	ANTIBIOTIC	A drug used to kill or control bacteria and some other germs.
Germ-killing treatment	ANTIMICROBIAL	A substance or treatment that acts against microorganisms such as bacteria, fungi, or parasites.
Antiviral drug	ANTIRETROVIRAL	A drug that slows or stops the growth of certain viruses.
Side effect	ADVERSE EFFECT	An unwanted or harmful response to a treatment or medicine.
Walking	AMBULATE/AMBULATION/ AMBULATORY	To walk, or to be able to walk.
Severe allergy	ANAPHYLAXIS	A serious, potentially life-threatening allergic reaction.
Low red-cell count	ANEMIA	A reduced number of red blood cells or a low red-cell blood count.
Numbing medicine	ANESTHETIC	A drug or agent that reduces or removes the feeling of pain, sometimes by causing sleep.
Heart pain	ANGINA	Chest pain caused by inadequate blood flow to the heart muscle.
Heart pain	ANGINA PECTORIS	Another medical term for chest pain caused by reduced blood flow to the heart.
Loss of appetite	ANOREXIA	Lack of appetite or, in some contexts, a disorder involving refusal to eat.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Inner elbow area	ANTECUBITAL	Relating to the inner side of the elbow or forearm.
Protective protein	ANTIBODY	A protein made by the body in response to a foreign substance.
Seizure-prevention drug	ANTICONVULSANT	A medicine used to prevent or control seizures.
Cholesterol-lowering drug	ANTILIPEMIC	A drug that lowers fat or cholesterol levels in the blood.
Cough medicine	ANTITUSSIVE	A medicine used to reduce coughing.
Irregular heartbeat	ARRHYTHMIA	Any abnormal change in the normal heartbeat or rhythm.
Breathing material into the lungs	ASPIRATION	Entry of fluid, food, or other material into the lungs, often after vomiting.
Laboratory test	ASSAY	A laboratory test used to measure or identify something.
Check or evaluate	ASSESS	To examine, measure, evaluate, or look at something carefully.
Asthma	ASTHMA	A lung disease in which narrowed or tightened airways make breathing difficult.
Without symptoms	ASYMPTOMATIC	Having no noticeable symptoms.
Armpit	AXILLA	The armpit area.
Not cancerous	BENIGN	Not malignant and generally not cancerous.
Twice daily	BID	Prescription shorthand meaning twice a day.
Carried or stuck together	BINDING/BOUND	Carried by something, or made to stick or join together.
Drug availability	BIOAVAILABILITY	The amount or proportion of a drug that becomes available for the body to use.
Series of blood tests	BLOOD PROFILE	A group or panel of blood tests.
Large dose at once	BOLUS	A relatively large amount given all at one time.
Amount of mineral in bone	BONE MASS	The amount of calcium and other minerals in a given amount of bone.
Slow irregular heartbeats	BRADYARRHYTHMIAS	Slow heart rhythms that may also be irregular.
Slow heartbeat	BRADYCARDIA	A slower-than-usual heartbeat.
Narrowed airways	BRONCHOSPASM	Breathing difficulty caused by tightening of the airway muscles.
Cancer-causing	CARCINOGENIC	Capable of causing cancer.
Cancer type	CARCINOMA	A cancer that begins in lining or covering cells of the body.
Related to the heart	CARDIAC	Relating to the heart.
Resetting the heartbeat	CARDIOVERSION	Restoring a normal heart rhythm, often with a controlled electrical shock.
Tube	CATHETER	A thin tube used to give or remove fluids, or to perform certain medical procedures.
Epidural tube	CATHETER	A catheter placed near the spinal cord to deliver anesthesia during surgery.
Brain and spinal cord	CENTRAL NERVOUS SYSTEM (CNS)	The brain and spinal cord.
Brain injury	CEREBRAL TRAUMA	Damage to the brain caused by an injury.
Stopping	CESSATION	The act of stopping something.
Coronary heart disease	CHD	Disease of the blood vessels that supply the heart.
Cancer drug treatment	CHEMOTHERAPY	Treatment of disease, usually cancer, with chemical medicines.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Long-lasting	CHRONIC	Continuing for a long time or ongoing.
Related to patient care	CLINICAL	Pertaining to medical care or the care of patients.
Human research study	CLINICAL TRIAL	A research study involving human participants.
Unconscious state	COMA	A prolonged state of unconsciousness in which a person cannot be awakened normally.
All disease gone	COMPLETE RESPONSE	Total disappearance of the detectable disease being treated.
Present from birth	CONGENITAL	Present before or at birth.
Pink, irritated eye	CONJUNCTIVITIS	Redness and irritation of the thin membrane covering the eye.
Treatment to keep improvement	CONSOLIDATION PHASE	A treatment phase intended to make a remission last, usually after initial treatment.
Comparison study	CONTROLLED TRIAL	A study comparing an experimental treatment with a standard or control treatment.
Research partnership	COOPERATIVE GROUP	An association of institutions that work together on clinical research.
Related to heart arteries	CORONARY	Relating to the heart or the blood vessels that supply it.
Computerized X-ray scan	CT SCAN (CAT)	A series of computer-processed X-ray images that show sections of the body.
Germ-growth test	CULTURE	A test that grows or detects organisms that may cause infection.
Added together	CUMULATIVE	Added up from the beginning.
Related to the skin	CUTANEOUS	Relating to the skin.
Stroke	CVA	A stroke, also called a cerebrovascular accident.
Related to the skin	DERMATOLOGIC	Pertaining to the skin.
Lower blood-pressure number	DIASTOLIC	Relating to the lower blood-pressure number, when the heart relaxes.
Farther away	DISTAL	Toward the end or away from the center of the body.
Water pill	DIURETIC	A drug that increases urination.
Sound-wave blood-flow test	DOPPLER	A device or test using sound waves to assess blood flow.
Masked study	DOUBLE BLIND	A study in which neither the participants nor investigators know which treatment is being given.
Improper function	DYSFUNCTION	A state in which something does not work normally.
Abnormal cells	DYSPLASIA	Abnormal changes in the size, shape, or organization of cells.
Heart sound-wave test	ECHOCARDIOGRAM	An ultrasound test that creates pictures of the heart.
Swelling from fluid	EDEMA	Excess fluid collecting in body tissues.
Brain-wave test	EEG	A recording of the brain's electrical activity.
Effectiveness	EFFICACY	How well a treatment works under specified conditions.
Heart electrical tracing	ELECTROCARDIOGRAM	A tracing of the heart's electrical activity, also called an ECG or EKG.
Mineral imbalance	ELECTROLYTE IMBALANCE	An abnormal level or balance of minerals in the blood.
Vomiting	EMESIS	The act of vomiting.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Based on experience	EMPIRIC	Based on experience or likely cause rather than definitive test results.
Viewing inside the body	ENDOSCOPIC EXAMINATION	Looking inside the body with a lighted tube or camera.
Through the intestines	ENTERAL	Given through or involving the digestive tract.
Outside the spinal cord	EPIDURAL	Located outside the spinal cord covering, or medicine given into that space.
Remove completely	ERADICATE	To get rid of a disease, infection, or other problem.
Examined	EVALUATED, ASSESSED	Examined or checked for a medical condition.
Fast ethics review	EXPEDITED REVIEW	A rapid research-protocol review allowed for certain lower-risk studies.
Outside the body	EXTERNAL	Located or occurring outside the body.
Leak out	EXTRAVASATE	To leak outside the intended area, such as from a blood vessel into nearby tissue.
U.S. drug agency	FDA	The U.S. Food and Drug Administration, which regulates medicines and medical products.
Scar-like	FIBROUS	Containing many fibers, often resembling scar tissue.
Irregular quivering	FIBRILLATION	Very rapid, uncoordinated activity of the heart or another muscle.
Being put fully to sleep	GENERAL ANESTHESIA	Use of medicines to cause unconsciousness and prevent pain during a procedure.
Related to pregnancy	GESTATIONAL	Pertaining to pregnancy.
Red-cell percentage	HEMATOCRIT	The proportion of blood made up of red blood cells.
Bruise or blood collection	HEMATOMA	A collection of blood under the skin or in a tissue, often appearing as a bruise.
Blood-flow measurement	HEMODYNAMIC MEASURING	Measuring blood flow and circulation.
Red-cell breakdown	HEMOLYSIS	Breakdown or destruction of red blood cells.
Heparin tube or port	HEPARIN LOCK	An intravenous access device kept open with a prescribed solution, sometimes containing heparin.
Liver tumor	HEPATOMA	A tumor of the liver, often referring to hepatocellular carcinoma.
Inherited disease	HERITABLE DISEASE	A disease that can be passed through genes to future children.
Tissue-disease examination	HISTOPATHOLOGIC	Relating to examination of tissues or cells for disease.
Portable heart monitor	HOLTER MONITOR	A portable device that records heartbeats, usually for a day or longer.
High blood calcium	HYPERCALCEMIA	An abnormally high calcium level in the blood.
High blood potassium	HYPERKALEMIA	An abnormally high potassium level in the blood.
High blood sodium	HYPERNATREMIA	An abnormally high sodium level in the blood.
High blood pressure	HYPERTENSION	Blood pressure that is higher than recommended.
Low blood calcium	HYPOCALCEMIA	An abnormally low calcium level in the blood.
Low blood potassium	HYPOKALEMIA	An abnormally low potassium level in the blood.
Low blood sodium	HYPONATREMIA	An abnormally low sodium level in the blood.
Low blood pressure	HYPOTENSION	Blood pressure that is lower than expected.
Low blood oxygen	HYPOXEMIA	A low level of oxygen in the blood.
Low tissue oxygen	HYPOXIA	Too little oxygen reaching body tissues.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Removal of the uterus	HYSTERECTOMY	Surgical removal of the uterus; the ovaries and other structures may or may not also be removed.
Treatment-caused	IATROGENIC	Caused by medical treatment or a healthcare procedure.
Device research permission	IDE	Permission to study an unapproved medical device in people.
Cause unknown	IDIOPATHIC	Having no known cause.
Body protection	IMMUNITY	The body's defense against infection or other foreign substances.
Antibody protein	IMMUNOGLOBIN	A protein involved in making antibodies and immune defense; the standard spelling is immunoglobulin.
Immune-suppressing	IMMUNOSUPPRESSIVE	A drug or treatment that reduces the body's immune response.
Immune-based treatment	IMMUNOTHERAPY	Treatment that uses or changes the immune system, often against cancer or immune disease.
Abnormal function	IMPAIRED FUNCTION	Function that is reduced or not working normally.
Placed inside the body	IMPLANTED	Surgically or otherwise placed inside the body.
New-drug research permission	IND	Authorization to test an unapproved new drug in people.
Hardening	INDURATION	An area that has become unusually firm or hard.
Left in place	INDWELLING	Remaining in a particular location, such as a catheter.
Dead tissue from poor blood flow	INFARCT	Death of tissue caused by inadequate blood supply.
Disease that can spread	INFECTIOUS DISEASE	An illness caused by organisms that may spread between people or through other routes.
Swelling and irritation	INFLAMMATION	The body's response to injury or infection, often causing swelling, warmth, redness, or pain.
Slow delivery into the body	INFUSION	Slow delivery of a substance, usually through a vein or catheter.
Taking by mouth	INGESTION	Eating, drinking, or taking something into the body by mouth.
Antiviral immune protein	INTERFERON	A medicine or natural protein that helps the body act against viruses.
On and off	INTERMITTENT	Occurring repeatedly with pauses between episodes.
Inside the body	INTERNAL	Located or occurring within the body.
Inside	INTERIOR	Located on the inside.
Into a muscle	INTRAMUSCULAR	Given into a muscle.
Into the abdomen	INTRAPERITONEAL	Given into or located within the abdominal cavity.
Into spinal fluid	INTRATHECAL	Given into the fluid space around the spinal cord.
Into a vein	INTRAVENOUS (IV)	Given through a vein.
Into the bladder	INTRAVESICAL	Given into the bladder.
Place a breathing tube	INTUBATE	To place a tube into the airway.
Breaking the skin	INVASIVE PROCEDURE	A procedure that punctures, opens, or cuts the skin or enters the body.
Unapproved-drug study	INVESTIGATIONAL NEW DRUG (IND)	A new drug being studied before it has full approval for general use.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Unproven treatment method	INVESTIGATIONAL METHOD	A treatment method still being studied and not established as standard care.
Reduced blood flow	ISCHEMIA	Too little blood and oxygen reaching a tissue, usually because blood flow is reduced.
Open abdominal surgery	LAPAROTOMY	Surgery using an incision in the abdominal wall to reach the organs inside.
Abnormal area	LESION	A wound, injury, or area of abnormal tissue.
Very tired or sleepy	LETHARGY	Sleepiness, tiredness, or reduced energy.
Low white-cell count	LEUKOPENIA	A lower-than-normal number of white blood cells.
Fat	LIPID	A fat or fat-like substance.
Amount of fat	LIPID CONTENT	The amount of fat in a substance, tissue, or blood sample.
Cholesterol and fat panel	LIPID PROFILE (PANEL)	Blood tests measuring fats and cholesterol.
Numbing a small area	LOCAL ANESTHESIA	Numbing medicine used to prevent pain in a limited area.
Limited to one area	LOCALIZED	Restricted to one area.
Inner space	LUMEN	The hollow space inside a tube or organ, such as a blood vessel.
Lymph-vessel X-ray	LYMPHANGIOGRAPHY	An X-ray study of lymph vessels or nodes after contrast dye is injected.
Immune white blood cell	LYMPHOCYTE	A type of white blood cell that helps protect against infection.
Lymph-node cancer	LYMPHOMA	A cancer of lymph nodes or related lymphatic tissue.
Feeling unwell	MALAISE	A vague feeling of illness or bodily discomfort.
Not working correctly	MALFUNCTION	A condition in which a device, organ, or system does not work properly.
Cancerous growth	MALIGNANCY	A cancer or other tumor capable of growing and spreading.
Brain tumor	MEDULLABLASTOMA	A type of tumor that begins in the brain.
Abnormal red-cell development	MEGALOBLASTOSIS	A change in blood-forming cells that produces unusually large, abnormal red-cell precursors.
Break down in the body	METABOLIZE	To chemically process or break down a substance in the body.
Cancer spread	METASTASIS	Spread of cancer cells from one body part to another.
Antibiotic medicine	METRONIDAZOLE	A medicine used for certain bacterial and parasitic infections.
Heart attack	MI	Myocardial infarction, or death of heart muscle from blocked blood flow.
Small or slight	MINIMAL	Very small or slight.
Reduce	MINIMIZE	To reduce something as much as possible.
Check or watch	MONITOR	To observe, measure, or keep track of something over time.
Ease of movement	MOBILITY	The ability to move easily.
Illness or complication	MORBIDITY	Illness, disability, or an unwanted result of disease or treatment.
Death rate or death	MORTALITY	Death, or the rate of death in a population.
Ability to move	MOTILITY	The ability of a body part, cell, or organism to move.
Magnetic body scan	MRI	Pictures of the inside of the body made with magnets and radio waves rather than X-rays.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Moist body lining	MUCOSA, MUCOUS MEMBRANE	The moist lining of the digestive, respiratory, reproductive, and urinary passages.
Muscle aches	MYALGIA	Pain or aching in the muscles.
Related to heart muscle	MYOCARDIAL	Pertaining to the muscle of the heart.
Heart attack	MYOCARDIAL INFARCTION	Death of heart muscle caused by inadequate blood flow.
Nose-to-stomach tube	NASOGASTRIC TUBE	A tube passed through the nose into the stomach.
U.S. health institute	NCI	The National Cancer Institute.
Tissue death	NECROSIS	Death of cells or tissue.
Tumor	NEOPLASIA/NEOPLASM	An abnormal new growth that may be benign or malignant.
Nerve-tissue cancer	NEUROBLASTOMA	A cancer that develops from immature nerve tissue.
Related to the nervous system	NEUROLOGICAL	Pertaining to the brain, spinal cord, or nerves.
Low infection-fighting cells	NEUTROPENIA	A decrease in neutrophils, a major type of infection-fighting white blood cell.
U.S. health agency	NIH	The National Institutes of Health.
Not entering the body	NONINVASIVE	Not breaking, cutting, or entering the skin or body.
Hospital-acquired	NOSOCOMIAL	Acquired during a stay in a healthcare facility.
Blockage	OCCLUSION	Closing, blockage, or obstruction.
Cancer specialty	ONCOLOGY	The study and treatment of cancer and tumors.
Related to the eye	OPHTHALMIC	Pertaining to the eye.
Best choice	OPTIMAL	Best, most favorable, or most suitable.
By mouth	ORAL ADMINISTRATION	Giving a medicine through the mouth.
Related to bones	ORTHOPEDIC	Pertaining to bones, joints, muscles, or related structures.
Rare dense-bone disorder	OSTEOPETROSIS	A rare disorder in which bones become unusually dense but may be fragile.
Weak bones	OSTEOPOROSIS	A condition in which bones lose strength and become more likely to break.
Female sex glands	OVARIES	The organs that produce eggs and reproductive hormones.
Given by injection	PARENTERAL	Given by injection rather than through the digestive tract.
Open passage	PATENCY	The condition of being open and unobstructed.
How a disease develops	PATHOGENESIS	The process by which a disease or unhealthy condition develops.
Through the skin	PERCUTANEOUS	Done through or across the skin.
Away from the center	PERIPHERAL	At or toward the outer part rather than the center.
By mouth	PER OS (PO)	A prescription direction meaning by mouth.
How the body handles a drug	PHARMACOKINETICS	The study of how the body absorbs, distributes, changes, and removes a drug.
First drug-study phase	PHASE I	The first human study phase, usually focused on safety, effects, and dosing.
Early effectiveness study	PHASE II	A study phase examining safety and early evidence of benefit in people with a condition.
Large confirmation study	PHASE III	A larger study phase used to confirm safety and effectiveness and identify common side effects.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
After-approval study	PHASE IV	A study performed after approval to monitor safety or examine additional uses.
Vein irritation	PHLEBITIS	Irritation or inflammation of a vein.
Inactive treatment	PLACEBO	An inactive substance or treatment that looks like the real treatment.
Improvement from expectation	PLACEBO EFFECT	An improvement that occurs after an inactive treatment, often because of expectation or context.
Clotting blood particles	PLATELETS	Small blood components that help stop bleeding by forming clots.
Possible	POTENTIAL	Possible or capable of happening.
Make stronger	POTENTIATE	To increase or multiply the effect of a drug, treatment, or substance.
Effect booster	POTENTIATOR	An agent that helps another agent work more strongly.
Before birth	PRENATAL	Occurring before birth.
Preventive treatment	PROPHYLAXIS	A medicine or action used to prevent disease or infection.
As needed	PRN	Prescription shorthand meaning when needed.
Expected outlook	PROGNOSIS	The expected course and outcome of a disease.
Lying face down	PRONE	Lying on the stomach or front.
Study looking forward	PROSPECTIVE STUDY	A study that follows participants forward in time.
Artificial body part	PROSTHESIS	An artificial replacement for a body part.
Study plan	PROTOCOL	The written plan for a study or treatment.
Closer to the center	PROXIMAL	Closer to the center of the body or point of attachment.
Related to the lungs	PULMONARY	Pertaining to the lungs.
Every day	QD	Prescription shorthand meaning every day; clearer wording is preferred.
Four times daily	QID	Prescription shorthand meaning four times a day.
Radiation treatment	RADIATION THERAPY	Treatment using high-energy radiation to damage or destroy abnormal cells.
By chance	RANDOM	Selected or occurring by chance.
Chance assignment	RANDOMIZATION	Assigning participants to groups by chance.
Red blood cell	RBC	A red blood cell.
Genetically combined	RECOMBINANT	Made by combining genetic material from different sources.
Put back together	RECONSTITUTION	Restoring something by putting its parts back together or adding a liquid.
Happen again	RECUR	To happen again.
Not responding	REFRACTORY	Not responding adequately to treatment.
Regrowth or repair	REGENERATION	Growth again or replacement of lost or damaged tissue.
Treatment schedule	REGIMEN	The planned pattern, dose, and timing of treatment.
Return of disease	RELAPSE	Return of a disease after improvement or remission.
No detectable disease	REMISSION	Disappearance or reduction of evidence of disease; it may be partial or complete.
Related to kidneys	RENAL	Pertaining to the kidneys.
Can be repeated	REPLICABLE	Able to be repeated with similar results.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Remove surgically	RESECT	To remove part or all of an organ or tissue by surgery.
Study looking back	RETROSPECTIVE STUDY	A study that examines past records or past events.
Connective-tissue cancer	SARCOMA	A cancer arising from connective, bone, muscle, fat, or related tissues.
Calming medicine	SEDATIVE	A medicine that calms or makes a person sleepy.
Testicular cancer	SEMINOMA	A type of cancer arising in the testicle.
In order	SEQUENTIALLY	Happening one after another in order.
Sleepiness	SOMNOLENCE	Unusual sleepiness or a tendency to fall asleep.
Air-measuring instrument	SPIROMETER	An instrument that measures the amount of air moved into and out of the lungs.
Extent of disease	STAGING	Assessment of how far a disease has progressed or spread.
Usual accepted treatment	STANDARD OF CARE	A treatment plan generally accepted by the medical community as appropriate.
Narrowing	STENOSIS	Narrowing of a passage, duct, or blood vessel.
Mouth inflammation	STOMATITIS	Sores or inflammation inside the mouth.
Group for comparison	STRATIFY	To arrange people or results into groups for analysis.
Barely responsive state	STUPOR	A greatly reduced level of alertness in which a person is difficult to awaken or respond to.
Under the collarbone	SUBCLAVIAN	Located beneath the collarbone.
Under the skin	SUBCUTANEOUS	Beneath the skin.
Lying on the back	SUPINE	Lying face up on the back.
Care focused on comfort	SUPPORTIVE CARE	General care that relieves symptoms and supports the person without directly curing the underlying disease.
Having symptoms	SYMPTOMATIC	Showing or having symptoms.
Group of related findings	SYNDROME	A condition identified by a characteristic group of symptoms and signs.
Upper blood-pressure number	SYSTOLIC	Relating to the upper blood-pressure number when the heart contracts.
Birth-defect-causing	TERATOGENIC	Capable of causing abnormalities in a developing fetus.
Male sex glands	TESTES/TESTICLES	The organs that produce sperm and male reproductive hormones.
Clot formation	THROMBOSIS	Formation of a blood clot inside a blood vessel or other location.
Blood clot	THROMBUS	A blood clot formed within a blood vessel or the heart.
Three times daily	TID	Prescription shorthand meaning three times a day.
Gradual dose adjustment	TITRATION	Gradually changing a dose or solution to reach a desired effect.
Immune white blood cells	T-LYMPHOCYTES	White blood cells that help coordinate or carry out immune responses.
On the surface	TOPICAL	Applied to the surface, usually the skin or a mucous membrane.
Surface numbing medicine	TOPICAL ANESTHETIC	A numbing medicine applied to a particular surface area.

Lay term	Medical term	Lay-language explanation
Harmful effects	TOXICITY	Harmful or unwanted effects caused by a drug, chemical, or treatment.
Through the skin	TRANSDERMAL	Delivered through the skin.
Temporarily	TRANSIENTLY	For a short time or temporarily.
Injury	TRAUMA	Physical injury or wound.
Walking exercise machine	TREADMILL	A moving walking surface used for exercise or heart testing.
Absorption into tissue	UPTAKE	Absorbing or taking in a substance by living tissue.
Heart-valve repair	VALVULOPLASTY	A procedure that repairs or widens a heart valve.
Enlarged veins	VARICES	Abnormally enlarged or twisted veins.
Blood-vessel spasm	VASOSPASM	Sudden narrowing of blood vessels.
Disease carrier	VECTOR	An organism or carrier that can transmit a disease-causing microorganism.
Blood draw	VENIPUNCTURE	Puncturing a vein with a needle to draw blood or give treatment.
Parent-to-child spread	VERTICAL TRANSMISSION	Spread of an infection from a parent to a child, often during pregnancy, birth, or breastfeeding.
White blood cell	WBC	A white blood cell involved in immune defense.

Source and adaptation: Terms and concepts were checked against the University of Iowa Human Subjects Office, "Medical Terms in Lay Language," available at https://hso.research.uiowa.edu/get-started/guides-and-standard-operating-procedures-sops/medical-terms-lay-language. The explanations in this appendix are paraphrased for this dictionary and are not the only acceptable plain-language alternatives.

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